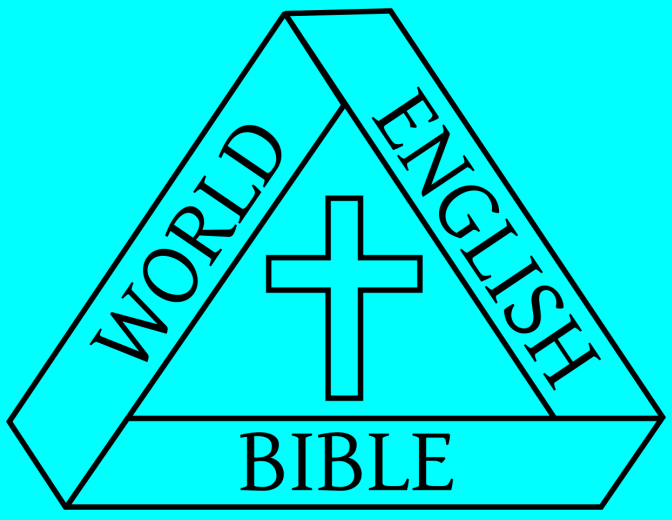
The

Holy Bible

with Deuterocanon/Apocrypha



The World English Bible

The World English Bible is in the Public Domain. That means that it is not copyrighted. However, "World English Bible" is a Trademark of eBible.org.

You may copy, publish, proclaim, distribute, redistribute, sell, give away, quote, memorize, read publicly, broadcast, transmit, share, back up, post on the Internet, print, reproduce, preach, teach from, and use the World English Bible as much as you want, and others may also do so. All we ask is that if you CHANGE the actual text of the World English Bible in any way, you not call the result the World English Bible any more. This is to avoid confusion, not to limit your freedom. The Holy Bible is God's Word. It belongs to God. He gave it to us freely, and we who have worked on this translation freely give it to you by dedicating it to the Public Domain.

Donations to help with the expenses of this project and thus help others have free access to the Word of God may be made to us, but are not required. Please see https://MLJohnson.org/partner/ if you are interested in helping to fund this work.

This is the 2020 stable text edition of the World English Bible. The main editing/updating work is done on all books. Although we may choose to consider corrections of obvious typos or problems in the text, we are done with style updates and modernization of the language used in this Bible translation, preferring to leave the text stable. New updates, if any, will be posted on https://eBible.org/web/ and at https://WorldEnglish.Bible.

PDF generated using Haiola and XeLaTeX on 22 May 2026 from source files dated 22 May 2026
9b352775-05c1-564e-85c2-0b15c0ea73b9

Contents

Preface 1
Genesis 4
Exodus 60
Leviticus 107
Numbers 142
Deuteronomy 191
Joshua 232
Judges 259
Ruth 287
1 Samuel 291
2 Samuel 327
1 Kings 357
2 Kings 392
1 Chronicles 425
2 Chronicles 457
Ezra 496
Nehemiah 508
Esther 524
Job 533
Psalms 567
Proverbs 650
Ecclesiastes 679
Song of Solomon 688
Isaiah 694
Jeremiah 757
Lamentations 824
Ezekiel 832
Daniel 890
Hosea 908
Joel 918
Amos 922
Obadiah 930
Jonah 932
Micah 935
Nahum 941
Habakkuk 943
Zephaniah 946
Haggai 949
Zechariah 951
Malachi 961

DC

Tobit 964
Judith 975
Esther (Greek) 992
Daniel (Greek) 1004
Wisdom of Solomon 1028
Sirach 1050
Baruch 1104
1 Maccabees 1112
2 Maccabees 1148
1 Esdras 1176
Prayer of Manasses 1195
Psalm 151 1196
3 Maccabees 1197
2 Esdras 1208
4 Maccabees 1243

NT

Matthew 1261
Mark 1299
Luke 1323
John 1363
Acts 1393
Romans 1432
1 Corinthians 1448
2 Corinthians 1463
Galatians 1473
Ephesians 1479
Philippians 1485
Colossians 1489
1 Thessalonians 1493
2 Thessalonians 1496
1 Timothy 1498
2 Timothy 1503
Titus 1506
Philemon 1508
Hebrews 1509
James 1521
1 Peter 1525
2 Peter 1530
1 John 1533
2 John 1537
3 John 1538
Jude 1539
Revelation 1541
Glossary 1559

Preface to the World English Bible

What is the Holy Bible?

The Holy Bible is a collection of books and letters written by many people who were inspired by the Holy Spirit of God. These books tell us how we can be saved from the evil of this world and gain eternal life that is truly worth living. Although the Holy Bible contains rules of conduct, it is not just a rule book. It reveals God's heart—a Father's heart, full of love and compassion. The Holy Bible tells you what you need to know and believe to be saved from sin and evil and how to live a life that is truly worth living, no matter what your current circumstances may be.

The Holy Bible consists of two main sections: the Old Testament (including Psalms and Proverbs) and the New Testament (Matthew through Revelation). The Old Testament records God's interaction with mankind before He sent His son to redeem us, while recording prophesy predicting that coming. The New Testament tells us of God's Son and Anointed One, Jesus, and the wonderful salvation that He purchased for us.

The same Holy Spirit who inspired the Holy Bible is living among us today, and He is happy to help you understand what He intended as you study His Word. Just ask Him, and He is more than happy to help you apply His message to your life.

The Old Testament was originally written mostly in Hebrew. The New Testament was originally written mostly in the common street Greek (not the formal Greek used for official legal matters). The Holy Bible is translated into many languages, and being translated into many more, so that everyone may have an opportunity to hear the Good News about Jesus Christ.†

Why was the World English Bible translated?

There are already many good translations of the Holy Bible into contemporary English. Unfortunately, almost all of them are restricted by copyright and copyright holder policy. This restricts publication and republication of God's Word in many ways, such as in downloadable files on the Internet, use of extensive quotations in books, etc. The World English Bible was commissioned by God in response to prayer about this subject.

Because the World English Bible is in the Public Domain (not copyrighted), it can be freely copied, distributed, and redistributed without any payment of royalties. You don't even have to ask permission to do so. You may publish the whole World English Bible in book form, bind it in leather, and sell it. You may incorporate it into your Bible study software. You may make and distribute audio recordings of it. You may broadcast it. All you have to do is maintain the integrity of God's Word before God, and reserve the name "World English Bible" for faithful copies of this translation.

How was the World English Bible translated?

The World English Bible is an update of the American Standard Version (ASV) of the Holy Bible, published in 1901. A custom computer program updated the archaic words and word forms to contemporary equivalents, and then a team of volunteers proofread and updated the grammar. The New Testament was updated in places to conform to the Byzantine Majority Text reconstruction of the original Greek manuscripts, thus taking advantage of the superior access to manuscripts that we have now compared to when the original ASV was translated.

What is different about the World English Bible?

The style of the World English Bible, while fairly literally translated, is in informal, spoken English. The World

† : "Christ" means "Anointed One".

English Bible is designed to sound good and be accurate when read aloud. It is not formal in its language, just as the original Greek of the New Testament was not formal. The WEB uses contractions rather freely.

The World English Bible doesn't capitalize pronouns pertaining to God. The original manuscripts made no such distinction. Hebrew has no such thing as upper and lower case, and the original Greek manuscripts were written in all upper case letters. Attempting to add in such a distinction raises some difficulties in translating dual-meaning Scriptures such as the coronation psalms.

The Classic World English Bible translates God's Proper Name in the Old Testament as "Yahweh." All other editions of the World English Bible translate the same name as "LORD" (all capital letters), or when used with "Lord" (mixed case, translated from "Adonai"), GOD. There are solid translational arguments for both traditions.

Because the World English Bible uses the Byzantine Majority Text (MT) as the primary basis for the New Testament, you may notice the following differences in comparing the WEB to other translations:

- The order of Matthew 23:13 and 14 is reversed in some translations.
- Luke 17:36 and Acts 15:34, which are not found in the majority of the Greek Manuscripts (and are relegated to footnotes in the WEB), may be included in some other translations.
- Romans 14:24-26 in the WEB may appear as Romans 16:25-27 in other translations.
- 1 John 5:7-8 contains an addition in some translations, including the KJV. Erasmus admitted adding this text to his published Greek New Testament, even though he could at first find no Greek manuscript support for it, because he was being pressured by men to do so, and because he didn't see any doctrinal harm in it. Lots of things not written by John in this letter are true, but we decline to add them to what the Holy Spirit inspired through John.

With all of the above and some other places where lack of clarity in the original manuscripts has led to multiple possible readings, significant variants are listed in footnotes. The reading that in our prayerful judgment is best is in the main text. Overall, the World English Bible doesn't differ very much from several other good contemporary English translations of the Holy Bible. The message of Salvation through Jesus Christ is still the same. The point of this translation was not to be very different (except for legal status), but to update the ASV for readability while retaining or improving the accuracy of that well-respected translation and retaining the public domain status of the ASV.

Does the World English Bible include the Apocrypha?

The World English Bible is an ecumenical project that includes books included in Bibles in many denominations. The main 66 books of the Old and New Testaments are recognized as Scripture by all true Christians. There are also books considered to be part of, depending on which book and who you ask, Deuterocanon, Apocrypha, and Pseudepigrapha. The Deuterocanon/Apocrypha books are included in the printed editions marked "Ecumenical" but not in the printed editions marked "Old and New Testaments".

The following books and parts of books are recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek, and Russian Orthodox Churches: *Tobit*, *Judith*, *Esther from the Greek Septuagint*, *The Wisdom of Solomon*, *Ecclesiasticus* (also called *The Wisdom of Jesus Son of Sirach*), *Baruch*, *The Song of the Three Holy Children*, *Susanna*, *Bel and the Dragon*, *1 Maccabees*, and *2 Maccabees*. In this edition, *The Letter of Jeremiah* is included as chapter 6 of *Baruch*. Three of those books come from parts of Daniel found in the Greek Septuagint, but not the Hebrew

Old Testament: *The Song of the Three Holy Children*, *Susanna*, and *Bel and the Dragon*. These three are included in *Daniel (Greek)*, in context, as they make more sense that way.

The following books are recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Greek and Russian Orthodox Churches, but not the Roman Catholic Church: 1 Esdras, The Prayer of Manasseh, Psalm 151, and 3 Maccabees. Note that 1 Esdras and the Prayer of Manasseh are also in an appendix to the Latin Vulgate Bible.

The Slavonic Bible includes 2 Esdras, but calls it 3 Esdras. This same book is in the Appendix to the Latin Vulgate as 4 Esdras.

An appendix to the Greek Septuagint contains 4 Maccabees. It is included for its historical value.

Among Christian denominations and among individual Christians, opinions vary widely on the Deuterocanon/Apocrypha, as do the collective names they give them. Many regard them as useful in gaining additional understanding of the Old and New Testaments and the hand of God in history, even if they don't give them the same status as the 66 books of the Old and New Testaments. They are included here in support of the churches and individuals who read them and use them, as separate from, but frequently used with, the core canon of the 66 books of the Holy Bible.

What are MT, TR, and NU?

In the footnotes, MT refers to the Byzantine Greek Majority Text New Testament, which is usually in the main text. TR stands for Textus Receptus, which is the Greek Text from which the King James Version New Testament was translated. NU stands for the Nestle-Aland/UBS critical text of the Greek New Testament, which is used as a basis for some other Bible translations.

More Information

For answers to frequently asked questions about the World English Bible, please visit our web site at WorldEnglish.Bible.

The First Book of Moses, Commonly Called Genesis

1 In the beginning, God† created the
heavens and the earth.
2 The earth was formless and empty.
Darkness was on the surface of the deep
and God's Spirit was hovering over the
surface of the waters.
3 God said, "Let there be light," and
there was light.
4 God saw the light, and saw that it was
good. God divided the light from the
darkness.
5 God called the light "day", and the
darkness he called "night". There was
evening and there was morning, the first
day.
6 God said, "Let there be an expanse in
the middle of the waters, and let it divide
the waters from the waters."
7 God made the expanse, and divided
the waters which were under the expanse
from the waters which were above the
expanse; and it was so.
8 God called the expanse "sky". There
was evening and there was morning, a
second day.
9 God said, "Let the waters under the sky
be gathered together to one place, and let
the dry land appear;" and it was so.
10 God called the dry land "earth", and
the gathering together of the waters he
called "seas". God saw that it was good.
11 God said, "Let the earth yield grass,
herbs yielding seeds, and fruit trees
bearing fruit after their kind, with their
seeds in it, on the earth;" and it was so.
12 The earth yielded grass, herbs
yielding seed after their kind, and trees
bearing fruit, with their seeds in it, after
their kind; and God saw that it was good.
13 There was evening and there was
morning, a third day.
14 God said, "Let there be lights in the
expanse of the sky to divide the day from
the night; and let them be for signs to
mark seasons, days, and years;
15 and let them be for lights in the
expanse of the sky to give light on the
earth;" and it was so.
16 God made the two great lights: the
greater light to rule the day, and the lesser
light to rule the night. He also made the
stars.
17 God set them in the expanse of the sky
to give light to the earth,
18 and to rule over the day and over the
night, and to divide the light from the
darkness. God saw that it was good.
19 There was evening and there was
morning, a fourth day.
20 God said, "Let the waters abound with
living creatures, and let birds fly above
the earth in the open expanse of the sky."
21 God created the large sea creatures
and every living creature that moves,
with which the waters swarmed, after
their kind, and every winged bird after its
kind. God saw that it was good.
22 God blessed them, saying, "Be fruitful,
and multiply, and fill the waters in the
seas, and let birds multiply on the earth."
23 There was evening and there was
morning, a fifth day.
24 God said, "Let the earth produce
living creatures after their kind, livestock,
creeping things, and animals of the earth
after their kind;" and it was so.
25 God made the animals of the earth
after their kind, and the livestock after
their kind, and everything that creeps on
the ground after its kind. God saw that it
was good.
26 God said, "Let's make man in our
image, after our likeness. Let them have
dominion over the fish of the sea, and
over the birds of the sky, and over the
livestock, and over all the earth, and over
every creeping thing that creeps on the
earth."
27 God created man in his own image. In
God's image he created him; male and
female he created them.
28 God blessed them. God said to them,
"Be fruitful, multiply, fill the earth, and

† **1:1** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

subdue it. Have dominion over the fish of the sea, over the birds of the sky, and over every living thing that moves on the earth."
29 God said, "Behold,‡ I have given you every herb yielding seed, which is on the surface of all the earth, and every tree, which bears fruit yielding seed. It will be your food.
30 To every animal of the earth, and to every bird of the sky, and to everything that creeps on the earth, in which there is life, I have given every green herb for food;" and it was so.
31 God saw everything that he had made, and, behold, it was very good. There was evening and there was morning, a sixth day.

2

1 The heavens, the earth, and all their vast array were finished.
2 On the seventh day God finished his work which he had done; and he rested on the seventh day from all his work which he had done.
3 God blessed the seventh day, and made it holy, because he rested in it from all his work of creation which he had done.
4 This is the history of the generations of the heavens and of the earth when they were created, in the day that Yahweh† God made the earth and the heavens.
5 No plant of the field was yet in the earth, and no herb of the field had yet sprung up; for Yahweh God had not caused it to rain on the earth. There was not a man to till the ground,
6 but a mist went up from the earth, and watered the whole surface of the ground.
7 Yahweh God formed man from the dust of the ground, and breathed into his nostrils the breath of life; and man became a living soul.
8 Yahweh God planted a garden eastward, in Eden, and there he put the man whom he had formed.
9 Out of the ground Yahweh God made every tree to grow that is pleasant to the sight, and good for food, including the tree of life in the middle of the garden and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.
10 A river went out of Eden to water the garden; and from there it was parted, and became the source of four rivers.
11 The name of the first is Pishon: it flows through the whole land of Havilah, where there is gold;
12 and the gold of that land is good. Bdellium‡ and onyx stone are also there.
13 The name of the second river is Gihon. It is the same river that flows through the whole land of Cush.
14 The name of the third river is Hiddekel. This is the one which flows in front of Assyria. The fourth river is the Euphrates.
15 Yahweh God took the man, and put him into the garden of Eden to cultivate and keep it.
16 Yahweh God commanded the man, saying, "You may freely eat of every tree of the garden;
17 but you shall not eat of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil; for in the day that you eat of it, you will surely die."
18 Yahweh God said, "It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make him a helper comparable to§ him."
19 Out of the ground Yahweh God formed every animal of the field, and every bird of the sky, and brought them to the man to see what he would call them. Whatever the man called every living creature became its name.
20 The man gave names to all livestock, and to the birds of the sky, and to every animal of the field; but for man there was not found a helper comparable to him.
21 Yahweh God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep. As the man slept, he took one of his ribs, and closed up the flesh in its place.
22 Yahweh God made a woman from the rib which he had taken from the man, and brought her to the man.
23 The man said, "This is now bone of my bones, and flesh of my flesh. She will

‡ **1:29** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
† **2:4** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **2:12** or, aromatic resin § **2:18** or, suitable for, or appropriate for.

be called ‘woman,’ because she was taken out of Man.”
24 Therefore a man will leave his father and his mother, and will join with his wife, and they will be one flesh.
25 The man and his wife were both naked, and they were not ashamed.

3

1 Now the serpent was more subtle than any animal of the field which Yahweh God had made. He said to the woman, “Has God really said, ‘You shall not eat of any tree of the garden’?”
2 The woman said to the serpent, “We may eat fruit from the trees of the garden,
3 but not the fruit of the tree which is in the middle of the garden. God has said, ‘You shall not eat of it. You shall not touch it, lest you die.’ ”
4 The serpent said to the woman, “You won’t really die,
5 for God knows that in the day you eat it, your eyes will be opened, and you will be like God, knowing good and evil.”
6 When the woman saw that the tree was good for food, and that it was a delight to the eyes, and that the tree was to be desired to make one wise, she took some of its fruit, and ate. Then she gave some to her husband with her, and he ate it, too.
7 Their eyes were opened, and they both knew that they were naked. They sewed fig leaves together, and made coverings for themselves.
8 They heard Yahweh God’s voice walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and the man and his wife hid themselves from the presence of Yahweh God among the trees of the garden.
9 Yahweh God called to the man, and said to him, “Where are you?”
10 The man said, “I heard your voice in the garden, and I was afraid, because I was naked; so I hid myself.”
11 God said, “Who told you that you were naked? Have you eaten from the tree that I commanded you not to eat from?”
12 The man said, “The woman whom you gave to be with me, she gave me fruit from the tree, and I ate it.”
13 Yahweh God said to the woman, “What have you done?”
The woman said, “The serpent deceived me, and I ate.”
14 Yahweh God said to the serpent,
“Because you have done this,
you are cursed above all livestock,
and above every animal of the field.
You shall go on your belly
and you shall eat dust all the days of your life.
15 I will put hostility between you and the woman,
and between your offspring and her offspring.
He will bruise your head,
and you will bruise his heel.”
16 To the woman he said,
“I will greatly multiply your pain in childbirth.
You will bear children in pain.
Your desire will be for your husband,
and he will rule over you.”
17 To Adam he said,
“Because you have listened to your wife’s voice,
and have eaten from the tree,
about which I commanded you,
saying, ‘You shall not eat of it,’
the ground is cursed for your sake.
You will eat from it with much labor all the days of your life.
18 It will yield thorns and thistles to you;
and you will eat the herb of the field.
19 You will eat bread by the sweat of your face until you return to the ground,
for you were taken out of it.
For you are dust,
and you shall return to dust.”
20 The man called his wife Eve because she would be the mother of all the living.
21 Yahweh God made garments of animal skins for Adam and for his wife, and clothed them.
22 Yahweh God said, “Behold, the man has become like one of us, knowing good and evil. Now, lest he reach out his hand, and also take of the tree of life, and eat, and live forever—”

23 Therefore Yahweh God sent him out
from the garden of Eden, to till the ground
from which he was taken.
24 So he drove out the man; and he
placed cherubim† at the east of the garden
of Eden, and a flaming sword which
turned every way, to guard the way to the
tree of life.

4

1 The man knew† Eve his wife. She
conceived,‡ and gave birth to Cain, and
said, "I have gotten a man with Yahweh's
help."
2 Again she gave birth, to Cain's brother
Abel. Abel was a keeper of sheep, but Cain
was a tiller of the ground.
3 As time passed, Cain brought an
offering to Yahweh from the fruit of the
ground.
4 Abel also brought some of the
firstborn of his flock and of its fat.
Yahweh respected Abel and his offering,
5 but he didn't respect Cain and his
offering. Cain was very angry, and the
expression on his face fell.
6 Yahweh said to Cain, "Why are you
angry? Why has the expression of your
face fallen?
7 If you do well, won't it be lifted up? If
you don't do well, sin crouches at the
door. Its desire is for you, but you are to
rule over it."
8 Cain said to Abel, his brother, "Let's go
into the field." While they were in the
field, Cain rose up against Abel, his
brother, and killed him.
9 Yahweh said to Cain, "Where is Abel,
your brother?"
He said, "I don't know. Am I my
brother's keeper?"
10 Yahweh said, "What have you done?
The voice of your brother's blood cries to
me from the ground.
11 Now you are cursed because of the
ground, which has opened its mouth to
receive your brother's blood from your
hand.
12 From now on, when you till the
ground, it won't yield its strength to you.
You will be a fugitive and a wanderer in
the earth."
13 Cain said to Yahweh, "My punishment
is greater than I can bear.
14 Behold, you have driven me out today
from the surface of the ground. I will be
hidden from your face, and I will be a
fugitive and a wanderer in the earth.
Whoever finds me will kill me."
15 Yahweh said to him, "Therefore
whoever slays Cain, vengeance will be
taken on him sevenfold." Yahweh
appointed a sign for Cain, so that anyone
finding him would not strike him.
16 Cain left Yahweh's presence, and
lived in the land of Nod, east of Eden.
17 Cain knew his wife. She conceived,
and gave birth to Enoch. He built a city,
and named the city after the name of his
son, Enoch.
18 Irad was born to Enoch. Irad became
the father of Mehujael. Mehujael became
the father of Methushael. Methushael
became the father of Lamech.
19 Lamech took two wives: the name of
the first one was Adah, and the name of
the second one was Zillah.
20 Adah gave birth to Jabal, who was the
father of those who dwell in tents and
have livestock.
21 His brother's name was Jubal, who
was the father of all who handle the harp
and pipe.
22 Zillah also gave birth to Tubal Cain,
the forger of every cutting instrument of
bronze and iron. Tubal Cain's sister was
Naamah.
23 Lamech said to his wives,
"Adah and Zillah, hear my voice.
You wives of Lamech, listen to my
speech,
for I have slain a man for wounding me,
a young man for bruising me.
24 If Cain will be avenged seven times,
truly Lamech seventy-seven times."
25 Adam knew his wife again. She gave
birth to a son, and named him Seth,
saying, "for God has given me another
child instead of Abel, for Cain killed him."

† **3:24** cherubim are powerful angelic creatures, messengers of God with wings. See Ezekiel 10. † **4:1** or, lay with, or, had relations with ‡ **4:1** or, became pregnant

26 A son was also born to Seth, and he named him Enosh. At that time men began to call on Yahweh's name.

5

1 This is the book of the generations of Adam. In the day that God created man, he made him in God's likeness.
2 He created them male and female, and blessed them. On the day they were created, he named them Adam.†
3 Adam lived one hundred thirty years, and became the father of a son in his own likeness, after his image, and named him Seth.
4 The days of Adam after he became the father of Seth were eight hundred years, and he became the father of other sons and daughters.
5 All the days that Adam lived were nine hundred thirty years, then he died.
6 Seth lived one hundred five years, then became the father of Enosh.
7 Seth lived after he became the father of Enosh eight hundred seven years, and became the father of other sons and daughters.
8 All of the days of Seth were nine hundred twelve years, then he died.
9 Enosh lived ninety years, and became the father of Kenan.
10 Enosh lived after he became the father of Kenan eight hundred fifteen years, and became the father of other sons and daughters.
11 All of the days of Enosh were nine hundred five years, then he died.
12 Kenan lived seventy years, then became the father of Mahalalel.
13 Kenan lived after he became the father of Mahalalel eight hundred forty years, and became the father of other sons and daughters
14 and all of the days of Kenan were nine hundred ten years, then he died.
15 Mahalalel lived sixty-five years, then became the father of Jared.
16 Mahalalel lived after he became the father of Jared eight hundred thirty years, and became the father of other sons and daughters.
17 All of the days of Mahalalel were eight hundred ninety-five years, then he died.
18 Jared lived one hundred sixty-two years, then became the father of Enoch.
19 Jared lived after he became the father of Enoch eight hundred years, and became the father of other sons and daughters.
20 All of the days of Jared were nine hundred sixty-two years, then he died.
21 Enoch lived sixty-five years, then became the father of Methuselah.
22 After Methuselah's birth, Enoch walked with God for three hundred years, and became the father of more sons and daughters.
23 All the days of Enoch were three hundred sixty-five years.
24 Enoch walked with God, and he was not found, for God took him.
25 Methuselah lived one hundred eighty-seven years, then became the father of Lamech.
26 Methuselah lived after he became the father of Lamech seven hundred eighty-two years, and became the father of other sons and daughters.
27 All the days of Methuselah were nine hundred sixty-nine years, then he died.
28 Lamech lived one hundred eighty-two years, then became the father of a son.
29 He named him Noah, saying, "This one will comfort us in our work and in the toil of our hands, caused by the ground which Yahweh has cursed."
30 Lamech lived after he became the father of Noah five hundred ninety-five years, and became the father of other sons and daughters.
31 All the days of Lamech were seven hundred seventy-seven years, then he died.
32 Noah was five hundred years old, then Noah became the father of Shem, Ham, and Japheth.

6

1 When men began to multiply on the surface of the ground, and daughters were born to them,

† **5:2** "Adam" and "Man" are spelled with the exact same consonants in Hebrew, so this can be correctly translated either way.

2 God's sons saw that men's daughters
were beautiful, and they took any that
they wanted for themselves as wives.
3 Yahweh said, "My Spirit will not strive
with man forever, because he also is flesh;
so his days will be one hundred twenty
years."
4 The Nephilim† were in the earth in
those days, and also after that, when God's
sons came in to men's daughters and had
children with them. Those were the
mighty men who were of old, men of
renown.
5 Yahweh saw that the wickedness of
man was great in the earth, and that every
imagination of the thoughts of man's
heart was continually only evil.
6 Yahweh was sorry that he had made
man on the earth, and it grieved him in
his heart.
7 Yahweh said, "I will destroy man
whom I have created from the surface of
the ground—man, along with animals,
creeping things, and birds of the sky—for I
am sorry that I have made them."
8 But Noah found favor in Yahweh's
eyes.

9 This is the history of the generations of
Noah: Noah was a righteous man,
blameless among the people of his time.
Noah walked with God.
10 Noah became the father of three sons:
Shem, Ham, and Japheth.
11 The earth was corrupt before God,
and the earth was filled with violence.
12 God saw the earth, and saw that it
was corrupt, for all flesh had corrupted
their way on the earth.

13 God said to Noah, "I will bring an end
to all flesh, for the earth is filled with
violence through them. Behold, I will
destroy them and the earth.
14 Make a ship of gopher wood. You
shall make rooms in the ship, and shall
seal it inside and outside with pitch.
15 This is how you shall make it. The
length of the ship shall be three hundred
cubits,‡ its width fifty cubits, and its
height thirty cubits.
16 You shall make a roof in the ship, and
you shall finish it to a cubit upward. You
shall set the door of the ship in its side.
You shall make it with lower, second, and
third levels.
17 I, even I, will bring the flood of waters
on this earth, to destroy all flesh having
the breath of life from under the sky.
Everything that is in the earth will die.
18 But I will establish my covenant with
you. You shall come into the ship, you,
your sons, your wife, and your sons' wives
with you.
19 Of every living thing of all flesh, you
shall bring two of every sort into the ship,
to keep them alive with you. They shall be
male and female.
20 Of the birds after their kind, of the
livestock after their kind, of every
creeping thing of the ground after its
kind, two of every sort will come to you, to
keep them alive.
21 Take with you some of all food that is
eaten, and gather it to yourself; and it will
be for food for you, and for them."
22 Thus Noah did. He did all that God
commanded him.

7

1 Yahweh said to Noah, "Come with all
of your household into the ship, for I have
seen your righteousness before me in this
generation.
2 You shall take seven pairs of every
clean animal with you, the male and his
female. Of the animals that are not clean,
take two, the male and his female.
3 Also of the birds of the sky, seven and
seven, male and female, to keep seed alive
on the surface of all the earth.
4 In seven days, I will cause it to rain on
the earth for forty days and forty nights. I
will destroy every living thing that I have
made from the surface of the ground."

5 Noah did everything that Yahweh
commanded him.

6 Noah was six hundred years old when
the flood of waters came on the earth.

† **6:4** or, giants ‡ **6:15** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

7 Noah went into the ship with his sons,
his wife, and his sons' wives, because of
the floodwaters.
8 Clean animals, unclean animals, birds,
and everything that creeps on the ground
9 went by pairs to Noah into the ship,
male and female, as God commanded
Noah.
10 After the seven days, the floodwaters
came on the earth.
11 In the six hundredth year of Noah's
life, in the second month, on the
seventeenth day of the month, on that day
all the fountains of the great deep burst
open, and the sky's windows opened.
12 It rained on the earth forty days and
forty nights.
13 In the same day Noah, and Shem,
Ham, and Japheth—the sons of Noah—and
Noah's wife and the three wives of his
sons with them, entered into the ship—
14 they, and every animal after its kind,
all the livestock after their kind, every
creeping thing that creeps on the earth
after its kind, and every bird after its kind,
every bird of every sort.
15 Pairs from all flesh with the breath of
life in them went into the ship to Noah.
16 Those who went in, went in male and
female of all flesh, as God commanded
him; then Yahweh shut him in.
17 The flood was forty days on the earth.
The waters increased, and lifted up the
ship, and it was lifted up above the earth.
18 The waters rose, and increased
greatly on the earth; and the ship floated
on the surface of the waters.
19 The waters rose very high on the
earth. All the high mountains that were
under the whole sky were covered.
20 The waters rose fifteen cubits† higher,
and the mountains were covered.
21 All flesh died that moved on the earth,
including birds, livestock, animals, every
creeping thing that creeps on the earth,
and every man.
22 All on the dry land, in whose nostrils
was the breath of the spirit of life, died.
23 Every living thing was destroyed that
was on the surface of the ground,
including man, livestock, creeping things,
and birds of the sky. They were destroyed
from the earth. Only Noah was left, and
those who were with him in the ship.
24 The waters flooded the earth one
hundred fifty days.

8

1 God remembered Noah, all the
animals, and all the livestock that were
with him in the ship; and God made a
wind to pass over the earth. The waters
subsided.
2 The deep's fountains and the sky's
windows were also stopped, and the rain
from the sky was restrained.
3 The waters continually receded from
the earth. After the end of one hundred
fifty days the waters receded.
4 The ship rested in the seventh month,
on the seventeenth day of the month, on
Ararat's mountains.
5 The waters receded continually until
the tenth month. In the tenth month, on
the first day of the month, the tops of the
mountains were visible.
6 At the end of forty days, Noah opened
the window of the ship which he had
made,
7 and he sent out a raven. It went back
and forth, until the waters were dried up
from the earth.
8 He himself sent out a dove to see if the
waters were abated from the surface of
the ground,
9 but the dove found no place to rest her
foot, and she returned into the ship to
him, for the waters were on the surface of
the whole earth. He put out his hand, and
took her, and brought her to him into the
ship.
10 He waited yet another seven days;
and again he sent the dove out of the ship.
11 The dove came back to him at evening
and, behold, in her mouth was a freshly
plucked olive leaf. So Noah knew that the
waters were abated from the earth.
12 He waited yet another seven days,
and sent out the dove; and she didn't
return to him any more.

† **7:20** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

13 In the six hundred first year, in the
first month, the first day of the month, the
waters were dried up from the earth.
Noah removed the covering of the ship,
and looked. He saw that the surface of the
ground was dry.
14 In the second month, on the
twenty-seventh day of the month, the
earth was dry.
15 God spoke to Noah, saying,
16 "Go out of the ship, you, your wife,
your sons, and your sons' wives with you.
17 Bring out with you every living thing
that is with you of all flesh, including
birds, livestock, and every creeping thing
that creeps on the earth, that they may
breed abundantly in the earth, and be
fruitful, and multiply on the earth."
18 Noah went out, with his sons, his
wife, and his sons' wives with him.
19 Every animal, every creeping thing,
and every bird, whatever moves on the
earth, after their families, went out of the
ship.
20 Noah built an altar to Yahweh, and
took of every clean animal, and of every
clean bird, and offered burnt offerings on
the altar.
21 Yahweh smelled the pleasant aroma.
Yahweh said in his heart, "I will not again
curse the ground any more for man's sake
because the imagination of man's heart is
evil from his youth. I will never again
strike every living thing, as I have done.
22 While the earth remains, seed time
and harvest, and cold and heat, and
summer and winter, and day and night
will not cease."

9

1 God blessed Noah and his sons, and
said to them, "Be fruitful, multiply, and
replenish the earth.
2 The fear of you and the dread of you
will be on every animal of the earth, and
on every bird of the sky. Everything that
moves along the ground, and all the fish of
the sea, are delivered into your hand.
3 Every moving thing that lives will be
food for you. As I gave you the green herb,
I have given everything to you.
4 But flesh with its life, that is, its blood,
you shall not eat.
5 I will surely require accounting for
your life's blood. At the hand of every
animal I will require it. At the hand of
man, even at the hand of every man's
brother, I will require the life of man.
6 Whoever sheds man's blood, his blood
will be shed by man, for God made man in
his own image.
7 Be fruitful and multiply. Increase
abundantly in the earth, and multiply in
it."
8 God spoke to Noah and to his sons with
him, saying,
9 "As for me, behold, I establish my
covenant with you, and with your
offspring after you,
10 and with every living creature that is
with you: the birds, the livestock, and
every animal of the earth with you, of all
that go out of the ship, even every animal
of the earth.
11 I will establish my covenant with you:
All flesh will not be cut off any more by
the waters of the flood. There will never
again be a flood to destroy the earth."
12 God said, "This is the token of the
covenant which I make between me and
you and every living creature that is with
you, for perpetual generations:
13 I set my rainbow in the cloud, and it
will be a sign of a covenant between me
and the earth.
14 When I bring a cloud over the earth,
that the rainbow will be seen in the cloud,
15 I will remember my covenant, which
is between me and you and every living
creature of all flesh, and the waters will
no more become a flood to destroy all
flesh.
16 The rainbow will be in the cloud. I
will look at it, that I may remember the
everlasting covenant between God and
every living creature of all flesh that is on
the earth."
17 God said to Noah, "This is the token of
the covenant which I have established
between me and all flesh that is on the
earth."
18 The sons of Noah who went out from
the ship were Shem, Ham, and Japheth.
Ham is the father of Canaan.

19 These three were the sons of Noah,
and from these the whole earth was
populated.
20 Noah began to be a farmer, and
planted a vineyard.
21 He drank of the wine and got drunk.
He was uncovered within his tent.
22 Ham, the father of Canaan, saw the
nakedness of his father, and told his two
brothers outside.
23 Shem and Japheth took a garment,
and laid it on both their shoulders, went
in backwards, and covered the nakedness
of their father. Their faces were
backwards, and they didn't see their
father's nakedness.
24 Noah awoke from his wine, and knew
what his youngest son had done to him.
25 He said,
"Canaan is cursed.
He will be a servant of servants to his
brothers."
26 He said,
"Blessed be Yahweh, the God of Shem.
Let Canaan be his servant.
27 May God enlarge Japheth.
Let him dwell in the tents of Shem.
Let Canaan be his servant."
28 Noah lived three hundred fifty years
after the flood.
29 All the days of Noah were nine
hundred fifty years, and then he died.

10

1 Now this is the history of the
generations of the sons of Noah and of
Shem, Ham, and Japheth. Sons were born
to them after the flood.
2 The sons of Japheth were: Gomer,
Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech,
and Tiras.
3 The sons of Gomer were: Ashkenaz,
Riphath, and Togarmah.
4 The sons of Javan were: Elishah,
Tarshish, Kittim, and Dodanim.
5 Of these were the islands of the
nations divided in their lands, everyone
after his language, after their families, in
their nations.
6 The sons of Ham were: Cush, Mizraim,
Put, and Canaan.
7 The sons of Cush were: Seba, Havilah,
Sabtah, Raamah, and Sabteca. The sons of
Raamah were: Sheba and Dedan.
8 Cush became the father of Nimrod. He
began to be a mighty one in the earth.
9 He was a mighty hunter before
Yahweh. Therefore it is said, "like Nimrod,
a mighty hunter before Yahweh".
10 The beginning of his kingdom was
Babel, Erech, Accad, and Calneh, in the
land of Shinar.
11 Out of that land he went into Assyria,
and built Nineveh, Rehoboth Ir, Calah,
12 and Resen between Nineveh and the
great city Calah.
13 Mizraim became the father of Ludim,
Anamim, Lehabim, Naphtuhim,
14 Pathrusim, Casluhim (which the
Philistines descended from), and
Caphtorim.
15 Canaan became the father of Sidon
(his firstborn), Heth,
16 the Jebusites, the Amorites, the
Girgashites,
17 the Hivites, the Arkites, the Sinites,
18 the Arvadites, the Zemarites, and the
Hamathites. Afterward the families of the
Canaanites were spread abroad.
19 The border of the Canaanites was
from Sidon—as you go toward Gerar—to
Gaza—as you go toward Sodom,
Gomorrah, Admah, and Zeboiim—to
Lasha.
20 These are the sons of Ham, after their
families, according to their languages, in
their lands and their nations.
21 Children were also born to Shem (the
elder brother of Japheth), the father of all
the children of Eber.
22 The sons of Shem were: Elam, Asshur,
Arpachshad, Lud, and Aram.
23 The sons of Aram were: Uz, Hul,
Gether, and Mash.
24 Arpachshad became the father of
Shelah. Shelah became the father of Eber.
25 To Eber were born two sons. The
name of the one was Peleg, for in his days
the earth was divided. His brother's name
was Joktan.
26 Joktan became the father of Almodad,
Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah,
27 Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah,
28 Obal, Abimael, Sheba,
29 Ophir, Havilah, and Jobab. All these
were the sons of Joktan.

30 Their dwelling extended from Mesha,
as you go toward Sephar, the mountain of
the east.
31 These are the sons of Shem, by their
families, according to their languages,
lands, and nations.
32 These are the families of the sons of
Noah, by their generations, according to
their nations. The nations divided from
these in the earth after the flood.

11

1 The whole earth was of one language
and of one speech.
2 As they traveled east,† they found a
plain in the land of Shinar, and they lived
there.
3 They said to one another, “Come, let’s
make bricks, and burn them thoroughly.”
They had brick for stone, and they used
tar for mortar.
4 They said, “Come, let’s build ourselves
a city, and a tower whose top reaches to
the sky, and let’s make a name for
ourselves, lest we be scattered abroad on
the surface of the whole earth.”
5 Yahweh came down to see the city and
the tower, which the children of men
built.
6 Yahweh said, “Behold, they are one
people, and they all have one language,
and this is what they begin to do. Now
nothing will be withheld from them,
which they intend to do.
7 Come, let’s go down, and there confuse
their language, that they may not
understand one another’s speech.”
8 So Yahweh scattered them abroad
from there on the surface of all the earth.
They stopped building the city.
9 Therefore its name was called Babel,
because there Yahweh confused the
language of all the earth. From there,
Yahweh scattered them abroad on the
surface of all the earth.
10 This is the history of the generations
of Shem: Shem was one hundred years
old when he became the father of
Arpachshad two years after the flood.
11 Shem lived five hundred years after
he became the father of Arpachshad, and
became the father of more sons and
daughters.
12 Arpachshad lived thirty-five years
and became the father of Shelah.
13 Arpachshad lived four hundred three
years after he became the father of
Shelah, and became the father of more
sons and daughters.
14 Shelah lived thirty years, and became
the father of Eber.
15 Shelah lived four hundred three
years after he became the father of Eber,
and became the father of more sons and
daughters.
16 Eber lived thirty-four years, and
became the father of Peleg.
17 Eber lived four hundred thirty years
after he became the father of Peleg, and
became the father of more sons and
daughters.
18 Peleg lived thirty years, and became
the father of Reu.
19 Peleg lived two hundred nine years
after he became the father of Reu, and
became the father of more sons and
daughters.
20 Reu lived thirty-two years, and
became the father of Serug.
21 Reu lived two hundred seven years
after he became the father of Serug, and
became the father of more sons and
daughters.
22 Serug lived thirty years, and became
the father of Nahor.
23 Serug lived two hundred years after
he became the father of Nahor, and
became the father of more sons and
daughters.
24 Nahor lived twenty-nine years, and
became the father of Terah.
25 Nahor lived one hundred nineteen
years after he became the father of Terah,
and became the father of more sons and
daughters.
26 Terah lived seventy years, and
became the father of Abram, Nahor, and
Haran.
27 Now this is the history of the
generations of Terah. Terah became the
father of Abram, Nahor, and Haran.
Haran became the father of Lot.

† **11:2** LXX reads “from the east”.

28 Haran died in the land of his birth, in
Ur of the Chaldees, while his father Terah
was still alive.
29 Abram and Nahor married wives.
The name of Abram's wife was Sarai, and
the name of Nahor's wife was Milcah, the
daughter of Haran, who was also the
father of Iscah.
30 Sarai was barren. She had no child.
31 Terah took Abram his son, Lot the son
of Haran, his son's son, and Sarai his
daughter-in-law, his son Abram's wife.
They went from Ur of the Chaldees, to go
into the land of Canaan. They came to
Haran and lived there.
32 The days of Terah were two hundred
five years. Terah died in Haran.

12

1 Now Yahweh said to Abram, "Leave
your country, and your relatives, and
your father's house, and go to the land
that I will show you.
2 I will make of you a great nation. I will
bless you and make your name great. You
will be a blessing.
3 I will bless those who bless you, and I
will curse him who treats you with
contempt. All the families of the earth will
be blessed through you."
4 So Abram went, as Yahweh had told
him. Lot went with him. Abram was
seventy-five years old when he departed
from Haran.
5 Abram took Sarai his wife, Lot his
brother's son, all their possessions that
they had gathered, and the people whom
they had acquired in Haran, and they
went to go into the land of Canaan. They
entered into the land of Canaan.
6 Abram passed through the land to the
place of Shechem, to the oak of Moreh. At
that time, Canaanites were in the land.
7 Yahweh appeared to Abram and said,
"I will give this land to your offspring."†
He built an altar there to Yahweh, who
had appeared to him.
8 He left from there to go to the
mountain on the east of Bethel and
pitched his tent, having Bethel on the
west, and Ai on the east. There he built an
altar to Yahweh and called on Yahweh's
name.
9 Abram traveled, still going on toward
the South.
10 There was a famine in the land.
Abram went down into Egypt to live as a
foreigner there, for the famine was severe
in the land.
11 When he had come near to enter
Egypt, he said to Sarai his wife, "See now, I
know that you are a beautiful woman to
look at.
12 It will happen that when the
Egyptians see you, they will say, 'This is
his wife.' They will kill me, but they will
save you alive.
13 Please say that you are my sister, that
it may be well with me for your sake, and
that my soul may live because of you."
14 When Abram had come into Egypt,
some Egyptians saw that the woman was
very beautiful.
15 The princes of Pharaoh saw her, and
praised her to Pharaoh; and the woman
was taken into Pharaoh's house.
16 He dealt well with Abram for her
sake. He had sheep, cattle, male donkeys,
male servants, female servants, female
donkeys, and camels.
17 Yahweh afflicted Pharaoh and his
house with great plagues because of Sarai,
Abram's wife.
18 Pharaoh called Abram and said,
"What is this that you have done to me?
Why didn't you tell me that she was your
wife?
19 Why did you say, 'She is my sister,' so
that I took her to be my wife? Now
therefore, see your wife, take her, and go
your way."
20 Pharaoh commanded men
concerning him, and they escorted him
away with his wife and all that he had.

13

1 Abram went up out of Egypt—he, his
wife, all that he had, and Lot with
him—into the South.
2 Abram was very rich in livestock, in
silver, and in gold.
3 He went on his journeys from the
South as far as Bethel, to the place where

† **12:7** or, seed

his tent had been at the beginning,
between Bethel and Ai,
4 to the place of the altar, which he had
made there at the first. There Abram
called on Yahweh's name.
5 Lot also, who went with Abram, had
flocks, herds, and tents.
6 The land was not able to bear them,
that they might live together; for their
possessions were so great that they
couldn't live together.
7 There was strife between the
herdsmen of Abram's livestock and the
herdsmen of Lot's livestock. The
Canaanites and the Perizzites lived in the
land at that time.
8 Abram said to Lot, "Please, let there be
no strife between you and me, and
between your herdsmen and my
herdsmen; for we are relatives.
9 Isn't the whole land before you?
Please separate yourself from me. If you
go to the left hand, then I will go to the
right. Or if you go to the right hand, then I
will go to the left."
10 Lot lifted up his eyes, and saw all the
plain of the Jordan, that it was
well-watered everywhere, before Yahweh
destroyed Sodom and Gomorrah, like the
garden of Yahweh, like the land of Egypt,
as you go to Zoar.
11 So Lot chose the Plain of the Jordan
for himself. Lot traveled east, and they
separated themselves from one another.
12 Abram lived in the land of Canaan,
and Lot lived in the cities of the plain, and
moved his tent as far as Sodom.
13 Now the men of Sodom were
exceedingly wicked and sinners against
Yahweh.
14 Yahweh said to Abram, after Lot was
separated from him, "Now, lift up your
eyes, and look from the place where you
are, northward and southward and
eastward and westward,
15 for I will give all the land which you
see to you and to your offspring forever.
16 I will make your offspring as the dust
of the earth, so that if a man can count the
dust of the earth, then your offspring may
also be counted.
17 Arise, walk through the land in its
length and in its width; for I will give it to
you."
18 Abram moved his tent, and came and
lived by the oaks of Mamre, which are in
Hebron, and built an altar there to
Yahweh.

14

1 In the days of Amraphel, king of
Shinar; Arioch, king of Ellasar;
Chedorlaomer, king of Elam; and Tidal,
king of Goiim,
2 they made war with Bera, king of
Sodom; Birsha, king of Gomorrah; Shinab,
king of Admah; Shemeber, king of
Zeboiim; and the king of Bela (also called
Zoar).
3 All these joined together in the valley
of Siddim (also called the Salt Sea).
4 They served Chedorlaomer for twelve
years, and in the thirteenth year they
rebelled.
5 In the fourteenth year Chedorlaomer
and the kings who were with him came
and struck the Rephaim in Ashteroth
Karnaim, the Zuzim in Ham, the Emim in
Shaveh Kiriathaim,
6 and the Horites in their Mount Seir, to
El Paran, which is by the wilderness.
7 They returned, and came to En
Mishpat (also called Kadesh), and struck
all the country of the Amalekites, and also
the Amorites, that lived in Hazazon
Tamar.
8 The king of Sodom, and the king of
Gomorrah, the king of Admah, the king of
Zeboiim, and the king of Bela (also called
Zoar) went out; and they set the battle in
array against them in the valley of Siddim
9 against Chedorlaomer king of Elam,
Tidal king of Goiim, Amraphel king of
Shinar, and Arioch king of Ellasar; four
kings against the five.
10 Now the valley of Siddim was full of
tar pits; and the kings of Sodom and
Gomorrah fled, and some fell there. Those
who remained fled to the hills.
11 They took all the goods of Sodom and
Gomorrah, and all their food, and went
their way.
12 They took Lot, Abram's brother's son,
who lived in Sodom, and his goods, and
departed.

13 One who had escaped came and told
Abram, the Hebrew. At that time, he lived
by the oaks of Mamre, the Amorite,
brother of Eshcol and brother of Aner.
They were allies of Abram.
14 When Abram heard that his relative
was taken captive, he led out his three
hundred eighteen trained men, born in
his house, and pursued as far as Dan.
15 He divided himself against them by
night, he and his servants, and struck
them, and pursued them to Hobah, which
is on the left hand of Damascus.
16 He brought back all the goods, and
also brought back his relative Lot and his
goods, and the women also, and the other
people.
17 The king of Sodom went out to meet
him after his return from the slaughter of
Chedorlaomer and the kings who were
with him, at the valley of Shaveh (that is,
the King's Valley).
18 Melchizedek king of Salem brought
out bread and wine. He was priest of God
Most High.
19 He blessed him, and said, "Blessed be
Abram of God Most High, possessor of
heaven and earth.
20 Blessed be God Most High, who has
delivered your enemies into your hand."
Abram gave him a tenth of all.
21 The king of Sodom said to Abram,
"Give me the people, and take the goods
for yourself."
22 Abram said to the king of Sodom, "I
have lifted up my hand to Yahweh, God
Most High, possessor of heaven and earth,
23 that I will not take a thread nor a
sandal strap nor anything that is yours,
lest you should say, 'I have made Abram
rich.'
24 I will accept nothing from you except
that which the young men have eaten,
and the portion of the men who went with
me: Aner, Eshcol, and Mamre. Let them
take their portion."

15

1 After these things Yahweh's word
came to Abram in a vision, saying, "Don't
be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your
exceedingly great reward."
2 Abram said, "Lord† Yahweh, what will
you give me, since I go childless, and he
who will inherit my estate is Eliezer of
Damascus?"
3 Abram said, "Behold, you have given
no children to me: and, behold, one born
in my house is my heir."
4 Behold, Yahweh's word came to him,
saying, "This man will not be your heir,
but he who will come out of your own
body will be your heir."
5 Yahweh brought him outside, and said,
"Look now toward the sky, and count the
stars, if you are able to count them." He
said to Abram, "So your offspring will be."
6 He believed in Yahweh, who credited
it to him for righteousness.
7 He said to Abram, "I am Yahweh who
brought you out of Ur of the Chaldees, to
give you this land to inherit it."
8 He said, "Lord Yahweh, how will I
know that I will inherit it?"
9 He said to him, "Bring me a heifer
three years old, a female goat three years
old, a ram three years old, a turtledove,
and a young pigeon."
10 He brought him all these, and divided
them in the middle, and laid each half
opposite the other; but he didn't divide
the birds.
11 The birds of prey came down on the
carcasses, and Abram drove them away.
12 When the sun was going down, a
deep sleep fell on Abram. Now terror and
great darkness fell on him.
13 He said to Abram, "Know for sure that
your offspring will live as foreigners in a
land that is not theirs, and will serve them.
They will afflict them four hundred years.
14 I will also judge that nation, whom
they will serve. Afterward they will come
out with great wealth;
15 but you will go to your fathers in
peace. You will be buried at a good old
age.
16 In the fourth generation they will
come here again, for the iniquity of the
Amorite is not yet full."

† **15:2** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai".

17 It came to pass that, when the sun
went down, and it was dark, behold, a
smoking furnace and a flaming torch
passed between these pieces.
18 In that day Yahweh made a covenant
with Abram, saying, "I have given this
land to your offspring, from the river of
Egypt to the great river, the river
Euphrates:
19 the land of the Kenites, the Kenizzites,
the Kadmonites,
20 the Hittites, the Perizzites, the
Rephaim,
21 the Amorites, the Canaanites, the
Girgashites, and the Jebusites."

16

1 Now Sarai, Abram's wife, bore him no
children. She had a servant, an Egyptian,
whose name was Hagar.
2 Sarai said to Abram, "See now, Yahweh
has restrained me from bearing. Please go
in to my servant. It may be that I will
obtain children by her." Abram listened
to the voice of Sarai.
3 Sarai, Abram's wife, took Hagar the
Egyptian, her servant, after Abram had
lived ten years in the land of Canaan, and
gave her to Abram her husband to be his
wife.
4 He went in to Hagar, and she
conceived. When she saw that she had
conceived, her mistress was despised in
her eyes.
5 Sarai said to Abram, "This wrong is
your fault. I gave my servant into your
bosom, and when she saw that she had
conceived, she despised me. May Yahweh
judge between me and you."
6 But Abram said to Sarai, "Behold, your
maid is in your hand. Do to her whatever
is good in your eyes." Sarai dealt harshly
with her, and she fled from her face.
7 Yahweh's angel found her by a
fountain of water in the wilderness, by
the fountain on the way to Shur.
8 He said, "Hagar, Sarai's servant, where
did you come from? Where are you
going?"
She said, "I am fleeing from the face of
my mistress Sarai."
9 Yahweh's angel said to her, "Return to
your mistress, and submit yourself under
her hands."
10 Yahweh's angel said to her, "I will
greatly multiply your offspring, that they
will not be counted for multitude."
11 Yahweh's angel said to her, "Behold,
you are with child, and will bear a son.
You shall call his name Ishmael, because
Yahweh has heard your affliction.
12 He will be like a wild donkey among
men. His hand will be against every man,
and every man's hand against him. He
will live opposed to all of his brothers."
13 She called the name of Yahweh who
spoke to her, "You are a God who sees," for
she said, "Have I even stayed alive after
seeing him?"
14 Therefore the well was called Beer
Lahai Roi.† Behold, it is between Kadesh
and Bered.
15 Hagar bore a son for Abram. Abram
called the name of his son, whom Hagar
bore, Ishmael.
16 Abram was eighty-six years old when
Hagar bore Ishmael to Abram.

17

1 When Abram was ninety-nine years
old, Yahweh appeared to Abram and said
to him, "I am God Almighty. Walk before
me and be blameless.
2 I will make my covenant between me
and you, and will multiply you
exceedingly."
3 Abram fell on his face. God talked with
him, saying,
4 "As for me, behold, my covenant is
with you. You will be the father of a
multitude of nations.
5 Your name will no more be called
Abram, but your name will be Abraham;
for I have made you the father of a
multitude of nations.
6 I will make you exceedingly fruitful,
and I will make nations of you. Kings will
come out of you.
7 I will establish my covenant between
me and you and your offspring after you

† **16:14** Beer Lahai Roi means "well of the one who lives and sees me".

throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant, to be a God to you and to your offspring after you.
8 I will give to you, and to your offspring after you, the land where you are traveling, all the land of Canaan, for an everlasting possession. I will be their God."
9 God said to Abraham, "As for you, you shall keep my covenant, you and your offspring after you throughout their generations.
10 This is my covenant, which you shall keep, between me and you and your offspring after you. Every male among you shall be circumcised.
11 You shall be circumcised in the flesh of your foreskin. It will be a token of the covenant between me and you.
12 He who is eight days old shall be circumcised among you, every male throughout your generations, he who is born in the house, or bought with money from any foreigner who is not of your offspring.
13 He who is born in your house, and he who is bought with your money, must be circumcised. My covenant shall be in your flesh for an everlasting covenant.
14 The uncircumcised male who is not circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin, that soul shall be cut off from his people. He has broken my covenant."
15 God said to Abraham, "As for Sarai your wife, you shall not call her name Sarai, but her name shall be Sarah.
16 I will bless her, and moreover I will give you a son by her. Yes, I will bless her, and she will be a mother of nations. Kings of peoples will come from her."
17 Then Abraham fell on his face, and laughed, and said in his heart, "Will a child be born to him who is one hundred years old? Will Sarah, who is ninety years old, give birth?"
18 Abraham said to God, "Oh that Ishmael might live before you!"
19 God said, "No, but Sarah, your wife, will bear you a son. You shall call his name Isaac.† I will establish my covenant with him for an everlasting covenant for his offspring after him.
20 As for Ishmael, I have heard you. Behold, I have blessed him, and will make him fruitful, and will multiply him exceedingly. He will become the father of twelve princes, and I will make him a great nation.
21 But I will establish my covenant with Isaac, whom Sarah will bear to you at this set time next year."
22 When he finished talking with him, God went up from Abraham.
23 Abraham took Ishmael his son, all who were born in his house, and all who were bought with his money: every male among the men of Abraham's house, and circumcised the flesh of their foreskin in the same day, as God had said to him.
24 Abraham was ninety-nine years old when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.
25 Ishmael, his son, was thirteen years old when he was circumcised in the flesh of his foreskin.
26 In the same day both Abraham and Ishmael, his son, were circumcised.
27 All the men of his house, those born in the house, and those bought with money from a foreigner, were circumcised with him.

18

1 Yahweh appeared to him by the oaks of Mamre, as he sat in the tent door in the heat of the day.
2 He lifted up his eyes and looked, and saw that three men stood near him. When he saw them, he ran to meet them from the tent door, and bowed himself to the earth,
3 and said, "My lord, if now I have found favor in your sight, please don't go away from your servant.
4 Now let a little water be fetched, wash your feet, and rest yourselves under the tree.
5 I will get a piece of bread so you can refresh your heart. After that you may go your way, now that you have come to your servant."

† **17:19** Isaac means "he laughs".

They said, “Very well, do as you have said.”
6 Abraham hurried into the tent to Sarah, and said, “Quickly prepare three seahs† of fine meal, knead it, and make cakes.”
7 Abraham ran to the herd, and fetched a tender and good calf, and gave it to the servant. He hurried to dress it.
8 He took butter, milk, and the calf which he had dressed, and set it before them. He stood by them under the tree, and they ate.
9 They asked him, “Where is Sarah, your wife?”
He said, “There, in the tent.”
10 He said, “I will certainly return to you at about this time next year; and behold, Sarah your wife will have a son.”
Sarah heard in the tent door, which was behind him.
11 Now Abraham and Sarah were old, well advanced in age. Sarah had passed the age of childbearing.
12 Sarah laughed within herself, saying, “After I have grown old will I have pleasure, my lord being old also?”
13 Yahweh said to Abraham, “Why did Sarah laugh, saying, ‘Will I really bear a child when I am old?’
14 Is anything too hard for Yahweh? At the set time I will return to you, when the season comes around, and Sarah will have a son.”
15 Then Sarah denied it, saying, “I didn’t laugh,” for she was afraid.
He said, “No, but you did laugh.”
16 The men rose up from there, and looked toward Sodom. Abraham went with them to see them on their way.
17 Yahweh said, “Will I hide from Abraham what I do,
18 since Abraham will surely become a great and mighty nation, and all the nations of the earth will be blessed in him?
19 For I have known him, to the end that he may command his children and his household after him, that they may keep the way of Yahweh, to do righteousness and justice; to the end that Yahweh may bring on Abraham that which he has spoken of him.”
20 Yahweh said, “Because the cry of Sodom and Gomorrah is great, and because their sin is very grievous,
21 I will go down now, and see whether their deeds are as bad as the reports which have come to me. If not, I will know.”
22 The men turned from there, and went toward Sodom, but Abraham stood yet before Yahweh.
23 Abraham came near, and said, “Will you consume the righteous with the wicked?
24 What if there are fifty righteous within the city? Will you consume and not spare the place for the fifty righteous who are in it?
25 May it be far from you to do things like that, to kill the righteous with the wicked, so that the righteous should be like the wicked. May that be far from you. Shouldn’t the Judge of all the earth do right?”
26 Yahweh said, “If I find in Sodom fifty righteous within the city, then I will spare the whole place for their sake.”
27 Abraham answered, “See now, I have taken it on myself to speak to the Lord, although I am dust and ashes.
28 What if there will lack five of the fifty righteous? Will you destroy all the city for lack of five?”
He said, “I will not destroy it if I find forty-five there.”
29 He spoke to him yet again, and said, “What if there are forty found there?”
He said, “I will not do it for the forty’s sake.”
30 He said, “Oh don’t let the Lord be angry, and I will speak. What if there are thirty found there?”
He said, “I will not do it if I find thirty there.”
31 He said, “See now, I have taken it on myself to speak to the Lord. What if there are twenty found there?”
He said, “I will not destroy it for the twenty’s sake.”

† **18:6** 1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks

32 He said, “Oh don’t let the Lord be
angry, and I will speak just once more.
What if ten are found there?”
He said, “I will not destroy it for the
ten’s sake.”
33 Yahweh went his way as soon as he
had finished communing with Abraham,
and Abraham returned to his place.

19

1 The two angels came to Sodom at
evening. Lot sat in the gate of Sodom. Lot
saw them, and rose up to meet them. He
bowed himself with his face to the earth,
2 and he said, “See now, my lords, please
come into your servant’s house, stay all
night, wash your feet, and you can rise up
early, and go on your way.”
They said, “No, but we will stay in the
street all night.”
3 He urged them greatly, and they came
in with him, and entered into his house.
He made them a feast, and baked
unleavened bread, and they ate.
4 But before they lay down, the men of
the city, the men of Sodom, surrounded
the house, both young and old, all the
people from every quarter.
5 They called to Lot, and said to him,
“Where are the men who came in to you
this night? Bring them out to us, that we
may have sex with them.”
6 Lot went out to them through the door,
and shut the door after himself.
7 He said, “Please, my brothers, don’t act
so wickedly.
8 See now, I have two virgin daughters.
Please let me bring them out to you, and
you may do to them what seems good to
you. Only don’t do anything to these men,
because they have come under the
shadow of my roof.”
9 They said, “Stand back!” Then they
said, “This one fellow came in to live as a
foreigner, and he appoints himself a
judge. Now we will deal worse with you
than with them!” They pressed hard on
the man Lot, and came near to break the
door.
10 But the men reached out their hand,
and brought Lot into the house to them,
and shut the door.
11 They struck the men who were at the
door of the house with blindness, both
small and great, so that they wearied
themselves to find the door.
12 The men said to Lot, “Do you have
anybody else here? Sons-in-law, your
sons, your daughters, and whomever you
have in the city, bring them out of the
place:
13 for we will destroy this place, because
the outcry against them has grown so
great before Yahweh that Yahweh has
sent us to destroy it.”
14 Lot went out, and spoke to his
sons-in-law, who were pledged to marry
his daughters, and said, “Get up! Get out
of this place, for Yahweh will destroy the
city!”
But he seemed to his sons-in-law to be
joking.
15 When the morning came, then the
angels hurried Lot, saying, “Get up! Take
your wife and your two daughters who
are here, lest you be consumed in the
iniquity of the city.”
16 But he lingered; and the men grabbed
his hand, his wife’s hand, and his two
daughters’ hands, Yahweh being merciful
to him; and they took him out, and set him
outside of the city.
17 It came to pass, when they had taken
them out, that he said, “Escape for your
life! Don’t look behind you, and don’t stay
anywhere in the plain. Escape to the
mountains, lest you be consumed!”
18 Lot said to them, “Oh, not so, my lord.
19 See now, your servant has found
favor in your sight, and you have
magnified your loving kindness, which
you have shown to me in saving my life. I
can’t escape to the mountain, lest evil
overtake me, and I die.
20 See now, this city is near to flee to,
and it is a little one. Oh let me escape
there (isn’t it a little one?), and my soul
will live.”
21 He said to him, “Behold, I have
granted your request concerning this
thing also, that I will not overthrow the
city of which you have spoken.

22 Hurry, escape there, for I can't do
anything until you get there." Therefore
the name of the city was called Zoar.†
23 The sun had risen on the earth when
Lot came to Zoar.
24 Then Yahweh rained on Sodom and
on Gomorrah sulfur and fire from
Yahweh out of the sky.
25 He overthrew those cities, all the
plain, all the inhabitants of the cities, and
that which grew on the ground.
26 But Lot's wife looked back from
behind him, and she became a pillar of
salt.
27 Abraham went up early in the
morning to the place where he had stood
before Yahweh.
28 He looked toward Sodom and
Gomorrah, and toward all the land of the
plain, and saw that the smoke of the land
went up as the smoke of a furnace.
29 When God destroyed the cities of the
plain, God remembered Abraham, and
sent Lot out of the middle of the
overthrow, when he overthrew the cities
in which Lot lived.
30 Lot went up out of Zoar, and lived in
the mountain, and his two daughters with
him; for he was afraid to live in Zoar. He
lived in a cave with his two daughters.
31 The firstborn said to the younger,
"Our father is old, and there is not a man
in the earth to come in to us in the way of
all the earth.
32 Come, let's make our father drink
wine, and we will lie with him, that we
may preserve our father's family line."
33 They made their father drink wine
that night: and the firstborn went in, and
lay with her father. He didn't know when
she lay down, nor when she arose.
34 It came to pass on the next day, that
the firstborn said to the younger, "Behold,
I lay last night with my father. Let's make
him drink wine again tonight. You go in,
and lie with him, that we may preserve
our father's family line."
35 They made their father drink wine
that night also. The younger went and lay
with him. He didn't know when she lay
down, nor when she got up.
36 Thus both of Lot's daughters were
with child by their father.
37 The firstborn bore a son, and named
him Moab. He is the father of the
Moabites to this day.
38 The younger also bore a son, and
called his name Ben Ammi. He is the
father of the children of Ammon to this
day.

† **19:22** Zoar means "little".

20

1 Abraham traveled from there toward
the land of the South, and lived between
Kadesh and Shur. He lived as a foreigner
in Gerar.
2 Abraham said about Sarah his wife,
"She is my sister." Abimelech king of
Gerar sent, and took Sarah.
3 But God came to Abimelech in a dream
of the night, and said to him, "Behold, you
are a dead man, because of the woman
whom you have taken; for she is a man's
wife."
4 Now Abimelech had not come near
her. He said, "Lord, will you kill even a
righteous nation?
5 Didn't he tell me, 'She is my sister'?
She, even she herself, said, 'He is my
brother.' I have done this in the integrity
of my heart and the innocence of my
hands."
6 God said to him in the dream, "Yes, I
know that in the integrity of your heart
you have done this, and I also withheld
you from sinning against me. Therefore I
didn't allow you to touch her.
7 Now therefore, restore the man's wife.
For he is a prophet, and he will pray for
you, and you will live. If you don't restore
her, know for sure that you will die, you,
and all who are yours."
8 Abimelech rose early in the morning,
and called all his servants, and told all
these things in their ear. The men were
very scared.
9 Then Abimelech called Abraham, and
said to him, "What have you done to us?
How have I sinned against you, that you
have brought on me and on my kingdom a
great sin? You have done deeds to me that
ought not to be done!"

10 Abimelech said to Abraham, “What
did you see, that you have done this
thing?”
11 Abraham said, “Because I thought,
‘Surely the fear of God is not in this place.
They will kill me for my wife’s sake.’
12 Besides, she is indeed my sister, the
daughter of my father, but not the
daughter of my mother; and she became
my wife.
13 When God caused me to wander from
my father’s house, I said to her, ‘This is
your kindness which you shall show to
me. Everywhere that we go, say of me,
“He is my brother.” ’ ”
14 Abimelech took sheep and cattle,
male servants and female servants, and
gave them to Abraham, and restored
Sarah, his wife, to him.
15 Abimelech said, “Behold, my land is
before you. Dwell where it pleases you.”
16 To Sarah he said, “Behold, I have
given your brother a thousand pieces of
silver. Behold, it is for you a covering of
the eyes to all that are with you. In front
of all you are vindicated.”
17 Abraham prayed to God. So God
healed Abimelech, his wife, and his
female servants, and they bore children.
18 For Yahweh had closed up tight all the
wombs of the house of Abimelech,
because of Sarah, Abraham’s wife.

21

1 Yahweh visited Sarah as he had said,
and Yahweh did to Sarah as he had
spoken.
2 Sarah conceived, and bore Abraham a
son in his old age, at the set time of which
God had spoken to him.
3 Abraham called his son who was born
to him, whom Sarah bore to him, Isaac.†
4 Abraham circumcised his son, Isaac,
when he was eight days old, as God had
commanded him.
5 Abraham was one hundred years old
when his son, Isaac, was born to him.
6 Sarah said, “God has made me laugh.
Everyone who hears will laugh with me.”
7 She said, “Who would have said to
Abraham that Sarah would nurse
children? For I have borne him a son in
his old age.”
8 The child grew and was weaned.
Abraham made a great feast on the day
that Isaac was weaned.
9 Sarah saw the son of Hagar the
Egyptian, whom she had borne to
Abraham, mocking.
10 Therefore she said to Abraham, “Cast
out this servant and her son! For the son
of this servant will not be heir with my
son, Isaac.”
11 The thing was very grievous in
Abraham’s sight on account of his son.
12 God said to Abraham, “Don’t let it be
grievous in your sight because of the boy,
and because of your servant. In all that
Sarah says to you, listen to her voice. For
your offspring will be named through
Isaac.
13 I will also make a nation of the son of
the servant, because he is your child.”
14 Abraham rose up early in the
morning, and took bread and a container
of water, and gave it to Hagar, putting it
on her shoulder; and gave her the child,
and sent her away. She departed, and
wandered in the wilderness of Beersheba.
15 The water in the container was spent,
and she put the child under one of the
shrubs.
16 She went and sat down opposite him,
a good way off, about a bow shot away.
For she said, “Don’t let me see the death of
the child.” She sat opposite him, and lifted
up her voice, and wept.
17 God heard the voice of the boy.
The angel of God called to Hagar out of
the sky, and said to her, “What troubles
you, Hagar? Don’t be afraid. For God has
heard the voice of the boy where he is.
18 Get up, lift up the boy, and hold him
with your hand. For I will make him a
great nation.”
19 God opened her eyes, and she saw a
well of water. She went, filled the
container with water, and gave the boy a
drink.
20 God was with the boy, and he grew.
He lived in the wilderness, and as he grew
up, he became an archer.

† **21:3** Isaac means “He laughs”.

21 He lived in the wilderness of Paran.
His mother got a wife for him out of the
land of Egypt.
22 At that time, Abimelech and Phicol
the captain of his army spoke to Abraham,
saying, “God is with you in all that you do.
23 Now, therefore, swear to me here by
God that you will not deal falsely with me,
nor with my son, nor with my son’s son.
But according to the kindness that I have
done to you, you shall do to me, and to the
land in which you have lived as a
foreigner.”
24 Abraham said, “I will swear.”
25 Abraham complained to Abimelech
because of a water well, which
Abimelech’s servants had violently taken
away.
26 Abimelech said, “I don’t know who
has done this thing. You didn’t tell me, and
I didn’t hear of it until today.”
27 Abraham took sheep and cattle, and
gave them to Abimelech. Those two made
a covenant.
28 Abraham set seven ewe lambs of the
flock by themselves.
29 Abimelech said to Abraham, “What
do these seven ewe lambs, which you
have set by themselves, mean?”
30 He said, “You shall take these seven
ewe lambs from my hand, that it may be a
witness to me, that I have dug this well.”
31 Therefore he called that place
Beersheba,‡ because they both swore an
oath there.
32 So they made a covenant at
Beersheba. Abimelech rose up with
Phicol, the captain of his army, and they
returned into the land of the Philistines.
33 Abraham planted a tamarisk tree in
Beersheba, and there he called on the
name of Yahweh, the Everlasting God.
34 Abraham lived as a foreigner in the
land of the Philistines many days.

22

1 After these things, God tested
Abraham, and said to him, “Abraham!”
He said, “Here I am.”
2 He said, “Now take your son, your only
son, Isaac, whom you love, and go into the
land of Moriah. Offer him there as a burnt
offering on one of the mountains which I
will tell you of.”
3 Abraham rose early in the morning,
and saddled his donkey; and took two of
his young men with him, and Isaac his
son. He split the wood for the burnt
offering, and rose up, and went to the
place of which God had told him.
4 On the third day Abraham lifted up his
eyes, and saw the place far off.
5 Abraham said to his young men, “Stay
here with the donkey. The boy and I will
go over there. We will worship, and come
back to you.”
6 Abraham took the wood of the burnt
offering and laid it on Isaac his son. He
took in his hand the fire and the knife.
They both went together.
7 Isaac spoke to Abraham his father, and
said, “My father?”
He said, “Here I am, my son.”
He said, “Here is the fire and the wood,
but where is the lamb for a burnt
offering?”
8 Abraham said, “God will provide
himself the lamb for a burnt offering, my
son.” So they both went together.
9 They came to the place which God had
told him of. Abraham built the altar there,
and laid the wood in order, bound Isaac
his son, and laid him on the altar, on the
wood.
10 Abraham stretched out his hand, and
took the knife to kill his son.
11 Yahweh’s angel called to him out of
the sky, and said, “Abraham, Abraham!”
He said, “Here I am.”
12 He said, “Don’t lay your hand on the
boy or do anything to him. For now I
know that you fear God, since you have
not withheld your son, your only son,
from me.”
13 Abraham lifted up his eyes, and
looked, and saw that behind him was a
ram caught in the thicket by his horns.
Abraham went and took the ram, and

‡ **21:31** Beersheba can mean “well of the oath” or “well of seven”. † **22:14** or, Yahweh-Jireh, or, Yahweh-Seeing

offered him up for a burnt offering
instead of his son.
14 Abraham called the name of that
place “Yahweh Will Provide”.† As it is said
to this day, “On Yahweh’s mountain, it will
be provided.”
15 Yahweh’s angel called to Abraham a
second time out of the sky,
16 and said, “ ‘I have sworn by myself,’
says Yahweh, ‘because you have done this
thing, and have not withheld your son,
your only son,
17 that I will bless you greatly, and I will
multiply your offspring greatly like the
stars of the heavens, and like the sand
which is on the seashore. Your offspring
will possess the gate of his enemies.
18 All the nations of the earth will be
blessed by your offspring, because you
have obeyed my voice.’ ”
19 So Abraham returned to his young
men, and they rose up and went together
to Beersheba. Abraham lived at
Beersheba.
20 After these things, Abraham was told,
“Behold, Milcah, she also has borne
children to your brother Nahor:
21 Uz his firstborn, Buz his brother,
Kemuel the father of Aram,
22 Chesed, Hazo, Pildash, Jidlaph, and
Bethuel.”
23 Bethuel became the father of
Rebekah. These eight Milcah bore to
Nahor, Abraham’s brother.
24 His concubine, whose name was
Reumah, also bore Tebah, Gaham,
Tahash, and Maacah.

23

1 Sarah lived one hundred twenty-seven
years. This was the length of Sarah’s life.
2 Sarah died in Kiriath Arba (also called
Hebron), in the land of Canaan. Abraham
came to mourn for Sarah, and to weep for
her.
3 Abraham rose up from before his dead
and spoke to the children of Heth, saying,
4 “I am a stranger and a foreigner living
with you. Give me a possession of a
burying-place with you, that I may bury
my dead out of my sight.”
5 The children of Heth answered
Abraham, saying to him,
6 “Hear us, my lord. You are a prince of
God among us. Bury your dead in the best
of our tombs. None of us will withhold
from you his tomb. Bury your dead.”
7 Abraham rose up, and bowed himself
to the people of the land, to the children of
Heth.
8 He talked with them, saying, “If you
agree that I should bury my dead out of
my sight, hear me, and entreat for me to
Ephron the son of Zohar,
9 that he may sell me the cave of
Machpelah, which he has, which is in the
end of his field. For the full price let him
sell it to me among you as a possession for
a burial place.”
10 Now Ephron was sitting in the middle
of the children of Heth. Ephron the Hittite
answered Abraham in the hearing of the
children of Heth, even of all who went in
at the gate of his city, saying,
11 “No, my lord, hear me. I give you the
field, and I give you the cave that is in it.
In the presence of the children of my
people I give it to you. Bury your dead.”
12 Abraham bowed himself down before
the people of the land.
13 He spoke to Ephron in the audience of
the people of the land, saying, “But if you
will, please hear me. I will give the price
of the field. Take it from me, and I will
bury my dead there.”
14 Ephron answered Abraham, saying to
him,
15 “My lord, listen to me. What is a piece
of land worth four hundred shekels of
silver† between me and you? Therefore
bury your dead.”
16 Abraham listened to Ephron.
Abraham weighed to Ephron the silver
which he had named in the hearing of the
children of Heth, four hundred shekels of
silver, according to the current
merchants’ standard.
17 So the field of Ephron, which was in
Machpelah, which was before Mamre, the
field, the cave which was in it, and all the

† **23:15** A shekel is about 10 grams, so 400 shekels would be about 4 kg. or 8.8 pounds.

trees that were in the field, that were in all of its borders, were deeded
18 to Abraham for a possession in the presence of the children of Heth, before all who went in at the gate of his city.
19 After this, Abraham buried Sarah his wife in the cave of the field of Machpelah before Mamre (that is, Hebron), in the land of Canaan.
20 The field, and the cave that is in it, were deeded to Abraham by the children of Heth as a possession for a burial place.

24

1 Abraham was old, and well advanced in age. Yahweh had blessed Abraham in all things.
2 Abraham said to his servant, the elder of his house, who ruled over all that he had, "Please put your hand under my thigh.
3 I will make you swear by Yahweh, the God of heaven and the God of the earth, that you shall not take a wife for my son of the daughters of the Canaanites, among whom I live.
4 But you shall go to my country, and to my relatives, and take a wife for my son Isaac."
5 The servant said to him, "What if the woman isn't willing to follow me to this land? Must I bring your son again to the land you came from?"
6 Abraham said to him, "Beware that you don't bring my son there again.
7 Yahweh, the God of heaven—who took me from my father's house, and from the land of my birth, who spoke to me, and who swore to me, saying, 'I will give this land to your offspring—he will send his angel before you, and you shall take a wife for my son from there.
8 If the woman isn't willing to follow you, then you shall be clear from this oath to me. Only you shall not bring my son there again."
9 The servant put his hand under the thigh of Abraham his master, and swore to him concerning this matter.
10 The servant took ten of his master's camels, and departed, having a variety of good things of his master's with him. He arose, and went to Mesopotamia, to the city of Nahor.
11 He made the camels kneel down outside the city by the well of water at the time of evening, the time that women go out to draw water.
12 He said, "Yahweh, the God of my master Abraham, please give me success today, and show kindness to my master Abraham.
13 Behold, I am standing by the spring of water. The daughters of the men of the city are coming out to draw water.
14 Let it happen, that the young lady to whom I will say, 'Please let down your pitcher, that I may drink,' then she says, 'Drink, and I will also give your camels a drink,'—let her be the one you have appointed for your servant Isaac. By this I will know that you have shown kindness to my master."
15 Before he had finished speaking, behold, Rebekah came out, who was born to Bethuel the son of Milcah, the wife of Nahor, Abraham's brother, with her pitcher on her shoulder.
16 The young lady was very beautiful to look at, a virgin. No man had known her. She went down to the spring, filled her pitcher, and came up.
17 The servant ran to meet her, and said, "Please give me a drink, a little water from your pitcher."
18 She said, "Drink, my lord." She hurried, and let down her pitcher on her hand, and gave him a drink.
19 When she had finished giving him a drink, she said, "I will also draw for your camels, until they have finished drinking."
20 She hurried, and emptied her pitcher into the trough, and ran again to the well to draw, and drew for all his camels.
21 The man looked steadfastly at her, remaining silent, to know whether Yahweh had made his journey prosperous or not.
22 As the camels had finished drinking, the man took a golden ring of half a

† **24:22** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

shekel† weight, and two bracelets for her hands of ten shekels weight of gold,
23 and said, “Whose daughter are you? Please tell me. Is there room in your father’s house for us to stay?”
24 She said to him, “I am the daughter of Bethuel the son of Milcah, whom she bore to Nahor.”
25 She said moreover to him, “We have both straw and feed enough, and room to lodge in.”
26 The man bowed his head, and worshiped Yahweh.
27 He said, “Blessed be Yahweh, the God of my master Abraham, who has not forsaken his loving kindness and his truth toward my master. As for me, Yahweh has led me on the way to the house of my master’s relatives.”
28 The young lady ran, and told her mother’s house about these words.
29 Rebekah had a brother, and his name was Laban. Laban ran out to the man, to the spring.
30 When he saw the ring, and the bracelets on his sister’s hands, and when he heard the words of Rebekah his sister, saying, “This is what the man said to me,” he came to the man. Behold, he was standing by the camels at the spring.
31 He said, “Come in, you blessed of Yahweh. Why do you stand outside? For I have prepared the house, and room for the camels.”
32 The man came into the house, and he unloaded the camels. He gave straw and feed for the camels, and water to wash his feet and the feet of the men who were with him.
33 Food was set before him to eat, but he said, “I will not eat until I have told my message.”
Laban said, “Speak on.”
34 He said, “I am Abraham’s servant.
35 Yahweh has blessed my master greatly. He has become great. Yahweh has given him flocks and herds, silver and gold, male servants and female servants, and camels and donkeys.
36 Sarah, my master’s wife, bore a son to my master when she was old. He has given all that he has to him.
37 My master made me swear, saying, ‘You shall not take a wife for my son from the daughters of the Canaanites, in whose land I live,
38 but you shall go to my father’s house, and to my relatives, and take a wife for my son.’
39 I asked my master, ‘What if the woman will not follow me?’
40 He said to me, ‘Yahweh, before whom I walk, will send his angel with you, and prosper your way. You shall take a wife for my son from my relatives, and of my father’s house.
41 Then you will be clear from my oath, when you come to my relatives. If they don’t give her to you, you shall be clear from my oath.’
42 I came today to the spring, and said, ‘Yahweh, the God of my master Abraham, if now you do prosper my way which I go—
43 behold, I am standing by this spring of water. Let it happen, that the maiden who comes out to draw, to whom I will say, “Please give me a little water from your pitcher to drink,”
44 then she tells me, “Drink, and I will also draw for your camels,”—let her be the woman whom Yahweh has appointed for my master’s son.’
45 Before I had finished speaking in my heart, behold, Rebekah came out with her pitcher on her shoulder. She went down to the spring, and drew. I said to her, ‘Please let me drink.’
46 She hurried and let down her pitcher from her shoulder, and said, ‘Drink, and I will also give your camels a drink.’ So I drank, and she also gave the camels a drink.
47 I asked her, and said, ‘Whose daughter are you?’ She said, ‘The daughter of Bethuel, Nahor’s son, whom Milcah bore to him.’ I put the ring on her nose, and the bracelets on her hands.
48 I bowed my head, and worshiped Yahweh, and blessed Yahweh, the God of my master Abraham, who had led me in the right way to take my master’s brother’s daughter for his son.
49 Now if you will deal kindly and truly

with my master, tell me. If not, tell me, that I may turn to the right hand, or to the left."
50 Then Laban and Bethuel answered, "The thing proceeds from Yahweh. We can't speak to you bad or good.
51 Behold, Rebekah is before you. Take her, and go, and let her be your master's son's wife, as Yahweh has spoken."
52 When Abraham's servant heard their words, he bowed himself down to the earth to Yahweh.
53 The servant brought out jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and clothing, and gave them to Rebekah. He also gave precious things to her brother and her mother.
54 They ate and drank, he and the men who were with him, and stayed all night. They rose up in the morning, and he said, "Send me away to my master."
55 Her brother and her mother said, "Let the young lady stay with us a few days, at least ten. After that she will go."
56 He said to them, "Don't hinder me, since Yahweh has prospered my way. Send me away that I may go to my master."
57 They said, "We will call the young lady, and ask her."
58 They called Rebekah, and said to her, "Will you go with this man?"
She said, "I will go."
59 They sent away Rebekah, their sister, with her nurse, Abraham's servant, and his men.
60 They blessed Rebekah, and said to her, "Our sister, may you be the mother of thousands of ten thousands, and let your offspring possess the gate of those who hate them."
61 Rebekah arose with her ladies. They rode on the camels, and followed the man. The servant took Rebekah, and went his way.
62 Isaac came from the way of Beer Lahai Roi, for he lived in the land of the South.
63 Isaac went out to meditate in the field at the evening. He lifted up his eyes and looked. Behold, there were camels coming.
64 Rebekah lifted up her eyes, and when she saw Isaac, she got off the camel.
65 She said to the servant, "Who is the man who is walking in the field to meet us?"
The servant said, "It is my master."
She took her veil, and covered herself.
66 The servant told Isaac all the things that he had done.
67 Isaac brought her into his mother Sarah's tent, and took Rebekah, and she became his wife. He loved her. So Isaac was comforted after his mother's death.

25

1 Abraham took another wife, and her name was Keturah.
2 She bore him Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, and Shuah.
3 Jokshan became the father of Sheba, and Dedan. The sons of Dedan were Asshurim, Letushim, and Leummim.
4 The sons of Midian were Ephah, Epher, Hanoch, Abida, and Eldaah. All these were the children of Keturah.
5 Abraham gave all that he had to Isaac,
6 but Abraham gave gifts to the sons of Abraham's concubines. While he still lived, he sent them away from Isaac his son, eastward, to the east country.
7 These are the days of the years of Abraham's life which he lived: one hundred seventy-five years.
8 Abraham gave up his spirit, and died at a good old age, an old man, and full of years, and was gathered to his people.
9 Isaac and Ishmael, his sons, buried him in the cave of Machpelah, in the field of Ephron, the son of Zohar the Hittite, which is near Mamre,
10 the field which Abraham purchased from the children of Heth. Abraham was buried there with Sarah, his wife.
11 After the death of Abraham, God blessed Isaac, his son. Isaac lived by Beer Lahai Roi.
12 Now this is the history of the generations of Ishmael, Abraham's son, whom Hagar the Egyptian, Sarah's servant, bore to Abraham.
13 These are the names of the sons of Ishmael, by their names, according to the order of their birth: the firstborn of

Ishmael, Nebaioth, then Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam,
14 Mishma, Dumah, Massa,
15 Hadad, Tema, Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah.
16 These are the sons of Ishmael, and these are their names, by their villages, and by their encampments: twelve princes, according to their nations.
17 These are the years of the life of Ishmael: one hundred thirty-seven years. He gave up his spirit and died, and was gathered to his people.
18 They lived from Havilah to Shur that is before Egypt, as you go toward Assyria. He lived opposite all his relatives.
19 This is the history of the generations of Isaac, Abraham's son. Abraham became the father of Isaac.
20 Isaac was forty years old when he took Rebekah, the daughter of Bethuel the Syrian of Paddan Aram, the sister of Laban the Syrian, to be his wife.
21 Isaac entreated Yahweh for his wife, because she was barren. Yahweh was entreated by him, and Rebekah his wife conceived.
22 The children struggled together within her. She said, "If it is like this, why do I live?" She went to inquire of Yahweh.
23 Yahweh said to her,
"Two nations are in your womb.
Two peoples will be separated from your body.
The one people will be stronger than the other people.
The elder will serve the younger."
24 When her days to be delivered were fulfilled, behold, there were twins in her womb.
25 The first came out red all over, like a hairy garment. They named him Esau.
26 After that, his brother came out, and his hand had hold on Esau's heel. He was named Jacob. Isaac was sixty years old when she bore them.
27 The boys grew. Esau was a skillful hunter, a man of the field. Jacob was a quiet man, living in tents.
28 Now Isaac loved Esau, because he ate his venison. Rebekah loved Jacob.
29 Jacob boiled stew. Esau came in from the field, and he was famished.
30 Esau said to Jacob, "Please feed me with some of that red stew, for I am famished." Therefore his name was called Edom.†
31 Jacob said, "First, sell me your birthright."
32 Esau said, "Behold, I am about to die. What good is the birthright to me?"
33 Jacob said, "Swear to me first."
He swore to him. He sold his birthright to Jacob.
34 Jacob gave Esau bread and lentil stew. He ate and drank, rose up, and went his way. So Esau despised his birthright.

26

1 There was a famine in the land, in addition to the first famine that was in the days of Abraham. Isaac went to Abimelech king of the Philistines, to Gerar.
2 Yahweh appeared to him, and said, "Don't go down into Egypt. Live in the land I will tell you about.
3 Live in this land, and I will be with you, and will bless you. For I will give to you, and to your offspring, all these lands, and I will establish the oath which I swore to Abraham your father.
4 I will multiply your offspring as the stars of the sky, and will give all these lands to your offspring. In your offspring all the nations of the earth will be blessed,
5 because Abraham obeyed my voice, and kept my requirements, my commandments, my statutes, and my laws."
6 Isaac lived in Gerar.
7 The men of the place asked him about his wife. He said, "She is my sister," for he was afraid to say, "My wife", lest, he thought, "the men of the place might kill me for Rebekah, because she is beautiful to look at."
8 When he had been there a long time, Abimelech king of the Philistines looked out at a window, and saw, and, behold, Isaac was caressing Rebekah, his wife.

† **25:30** "Edom" means "red".

9 Abimelech called Isaac, and said,
“Behold, surely she is your wife. Why did
you say, ‘She is my sister’?”
Isaac said to him, “Because I said, ‘Lest I
die because of her.’ ”
10 Abimelech said, “What is this you
have done to us? One of the people might
easily have lain with your wife, and you
would have brought guilt on us!”
11 Abimelech commanded all the
people, saying, “He who touches this man
or his wife will surely be put to death.”
12 Isaac sowed in that land, and reaped
in the same year one hundred times what
he planted. Yahweh blessed him.
13 The man grew great, and grew more
and more until he became very great.
14 He had possessions of flocks,
possessions of herds, and a great
household. The Philistines envied him.
15 Now all the wells which his father’s
servants had dug in the days of Abraham
his father, the Philistines had stopped,
and filled with earth.
16 Abimelech said to Isaac, “Go away
from us, for you are much mightier than
we.”
17 Isaac departed from there, encamped
in the valley of Gerar, and lived there.
18 Isaac dug again the wells of water,
which they had dug in the days of
Abraham his father, for the Philistines
had stopped them after the death of
Abraham. He called their names after the
names by which his father had called
them.
19 Isaac’s servants dug in the valley, and
found there a well of flowing† water.
20 The herdsmen of Gerar argued with
Isaac’s herdsmen, saying, “The water is
ours.” So he called the name of the well
Esek,‡ because they contended with him.
21 They dug another well, and they
argued over that, also. So he called its
name Sitnah.§
22 He left that place, and dug another
well. They didn’t argue over that one. So
he called it Rehoboth.† He said, “For now
Yahweh has made room for us, and we
will be fruitful in the land.”
23 He went up from there to Beersheba.
24 Yahweh appeared to him the same
night, and said, “I am the God of Abraham
your father. Don’t be afraid, for I am with
you, and will bless you, and multiply your
offspring for my servant Abraham’s sake.”
25 He built an altar there, and called on
Yahweh’s name, and pitched his tent
there. There Isaac’s servants dug a well.
26 Then Abimelech went to him from
Gerar with Ahuzzath his friend, and
Phicol the captain of his army.
27 Isaac said to them, “Why have you
come to me, since you hate me, and have
sent me away from you?”
28 They said, “We saw plainly that
Yahweh was with you. We said, ‘Let there
now be an oath between us, even between
us and you, and let’s make a covenant
with you,
29 that you will do us no harm, as we
have not touched you, and as we have
done to you nothing but good, and have
sent you away in peace.’ You are now the
blessed of Yahweh.”
30 He made them a feast, and they ate
and drank.
31 They rose up some time in the
morning, and swore an oath to one
another. Isaac sent them away, and they
departed from him in peace.
32 The same day, Isaac’s servants came,
and told him concerning the well which
they had dug, and said to him, “We have
found water.”
33 He called it “Shibah”.‡ Therefore the
name of the city is “Beersheba”§ to this
day.
34 When Esau was forty years old, he
took as wife Judith, the daughter of Beeri
the Hittite, and Basemath, the daughter of
Elon the Hittite.
35 They grieved Isaac’s and Rebekah’s
spirits.

† **26:19** Or, living. Or, fresh. ‡ **26:20** “Esek” means “contention”. § **26:21** “Sitnah” means “hostility”. † **26:22** “Rehoboth” means “broad places”. ‡ **26:33** Shibah means “oath” or “seven”. § **26:33** Beersheba means “well of the oath” or “well of the seven”

27

1 When Isaac was old, and his eyes were
dim, so that he could not see, he called
Esau his elder son, and said to him, “My
son?”
He said to him, “Here I am.”
2 He said, “See now, I am old. I don’t
know the day of my death.
3 Now therefore, please take your
weapons, your quiver and your bow, and
go out to the field, and get me venison.
4 Make me savory food, such as I love,
and bring it to me, that I may eat, and that
my soul may bless you before I die.”
5 Rebekah heard when Isaac spoke to
Esau his son. Esau went to the field to
hunt for venison, and to bring it.
6 Rebekah spoke to Jacob her son,
saying, “Behold, I heard your father speak
to Esau your brother, saying,
7 ‘Bring me venison, and make me
savory food, that I may eat, and bless you
before Yahweh before my death.’
8 Now therefore, my son, obey my voice
according to that which I command you.
9 Go now to the flock and get me two
good young goats from there. I will make
them savory food for your father, such as
he loves.
10 You shall bring it to your father, that
he may eat, so that he may bless you
before his death.”
11 Jacob said to Rebekah his mother,
“Behold, Esau my brother is a hairy man,
and I am a smooth man.
12 What if my father touches me? I will
seem to him as a deceiver, and I would
bring a curse on myself, and not a
blessing.”
13 His mother said to him, “Let your
curse be on me, my son. Only obey my
voice, and go get them for me.”
14 He went, and got them, and brought
them to his mother. His mother made
savory food, such as his father loved.
15 Rebekah took the good clothes of
Esau, her elder son, which were with her
in the house, and put them on Jacob, her
younger son.
16 She put the skins of the young goats
on his hands, and on the smooth of his
neck.
17 She gave the savory food and the
bread, which she had prepared, into the
hand of her son Jacob.
18 He came to his father, and said, “My
father?”
He said, “Here I am. Who are you, my
son?”
19 Jacob said to his father, “I am Esau
your firstborn. I have done what you
asked me to do. Please arise, sit and eat of
my venison, that your soul may bless me.”
20 Isaac said to his son, “How is it that
you have found it so quickly, my son?”
He said, “Because Yahweh your God
gave me success.”
21 Isaac said to Jacob, “Please come near,
that I may feel you, my son, whether you
are really my son Esau or not.”
22 Jacob went near to Isaac his father.
He felt him, and said, “The voice is Jacob’s
voice, but the hands are the hands of
Esau.”
23 He didn’t recognize him, because his
hands were hairy, like his brother Esau’s
hands. So he blessed him.
24 He said, “Are you really my son
Esau?”
He said, “I am.”
25 He said, “Bring it near to me, and I
will eat of my son’s venison, that my soul
may bless you.”
He brought it near to him, and he ate.
He brought him wine, and he drank.
26 His father Isaac said to him, “Come
near now, and kiss me, my son.”
27 He came near, and kissed him. He
smelled the smell of his clothing, and
blessed him, and said,
“Behold, the smell of my son
is as the smell of a field which
Yahweh has blessed.
28 God give you of the dew of the sky,
of the fatness of the earth,
and plenty of grain and new wine.
29 Let peoples serve you,
and nations bow down to you.
Be lord over your brothers.
Let your mother’s sons bow down to
you.
Cursed be everyone who curses you.
Blessed be everyone who blesses
you.”

30 As soon as Isaac had finished blessing
Jacob, and Jacob had just gone out from
the presence of Isaac his father, Esau his
brother came in from his hunting.
31 He also made savory food, and
brought it to his father. He said to his
father, “Let my father arise, and eat of his
son’s venison, that your soul may bless
me.”
32 Isaac his father said to him, “Who are
you?”
He said, “I am your son, your firstborn,
Esau.”
33 Isaac trembled violently, and said,
“Who, then, is he who has taken venison,
and brought it to me, and I have eaten of
all before you came, and have blessed
him? Yes, he will be blessed.”
34 When Esau heard the words of his
father, he cried with an exceedingly great
and bitter cry, and said to his father,
“Bless me, even me also, my father.”
35 He said, “Your brother came with
deceit, and has taken away your blessing.”
36 He said, “Isn’t he rightly named
Jacob? For he has supplanted me these
two times. He took away my birthright.
See, now he has taken away my blessing.”
He said, “Haven’t you reserved a blessing
for me?”
37 Isaac answered Esau, “Behold, I have
made him your lord, and all his brothers I
have given to him for servants. I have
sustained him with grain and new wine.
What then will I do for you, my son?”
38 Esau said to his father, “Do you have
just one blessing, my father? Bless me,
even me also, my father.” Esau lifted up
his voice, and wept.
39 Isaac his father answered him,
“Behold, your dwelling will be of the
fatness of the earth,
and of the dew of the sky from above.
40 You will live by your sword, and you
will serve your brother.
It will happen, when you will break loose,
that you will shake his yoke from off your
neck.”
41 Esau hated Jacob because of the
blessing with which his father blessed
him. Esau said in his heart, “The days of
mourning for my father are at hand. Then
I will kill my brother Jacob.”
42 The words of Esau, her elder son,
were told to Rebekah. She sent and called
Jacob, her younger son, and said to him,
“Behold, your brother Esau comforts
himself about you by planning to kill you.
43 Now therefore, my son, obey my
voice. Arise, flee to Laban, my brother, in
Haran.
44 Stay with him a few days, until your
brother’s fury turns away—
45 until your brother’s anger turns away
from you, and he forgets what you have
done to him. Then I will send, and get you
from there. Why should I be bereaved of
you both in one day?”
46 Rebekah said to Isaac, “I am weary of
my life because of the daughters of Heth.
If Jacob takes a wife of the daughters of
Heth, such as these, of the daughters of
the land, what good will my life do me?”

28

1 Isaac called Jacob, blessed him, and
commanded him, “You shall not take a
wife of the daughters of Canaan.
2 Arise, go to Paddan Aram, to the house
of Bethuel your mother’s father. Take a
wife from there from the daughters of
Laban, your mother’s brother.
3 May God Almighty bless you, and
make you fruitful, and multiply you, that
you may be a company of peoples,
4 and give you the blessing of Abraham,
to you and to your offspring with you, that
you may inherit the land where you
travel, which God gave to Abraham.”
5 Isaac sent Jacob away. He went to
Paddan Aram to Laban, son of Bethuel the
Syrian, the brother of Rebekah, Jacob’s
and Esau’s mother.
6 Now Esau saw that Isaac had blessed
Jacob and sent him away to Paddan Aram,
to take him a wife from there, and that as
he blessed him he gave him a command,
saying, “You shall not take a wife of the
daughters of Canaan;”
7 and that Jacob obeyed his father and
his mother, and was gone to Paddan
Aram.

8 Esau saw that the daughters of Canaan
didn't please Isaac, his father.
9 So Esau went to Ishmael, and took, in
addition to the wives that he had,
Mahalath the daughter of Ishmael,
Abraham's son, the sister of Nebaioth, to
be his wife.
10 Jacob went out from Beersheba, and
went toward Haran.
11 He came to a certain place, and stayed
there all night, because the sun had set.
He took one of the stones of the place, and
put it under his head, and lay down in that
place to sleep.
12 He dreamed and saw a stairway set
upon the earth, and its top reached to
heaven. Behold, the angels of God were
ascending and descending on it.
13 Behold, Yahweh stood above it, and
said, "I am Yahweh, the God of Abraham
your father, and the God of Isaac. I will
give the land you lie on to you and to your
offspring.
14 Your offspring will be as the dust of
the earth, and you will spread abroad to
the west, and to the east, and to the north,
and to the south. In you and in your
offspring, all the families of the earth will
be blessed.
15 Behold, I am with you, and will keep
you, wherever you go, and will bring you
again into this land. For I will not leave
you until I have done that which I have
spoken of to you."
16 Jacob awakened out of his sleep, and
he said, "Surely Yahweh is in this place,
and I didn't know it."
17 He was afraid, and said, "How
awesome this place is! This is none other
than God's house, and this is the gate of
heaven."
18 Jacob rose up early in the morning,
and took the stone that he had put under
his head, and set it up for a pillar, and
poured oil on its top.
19 He called the name of that place
Bethel, but the name of the city was Luz at
the first.
20 Jacob vowed a vow, saying, "If God
will be with me, and will keep me in this
way that I go, and will give me bread to
eat, and clothing to put on,
21 so that I come again to my father's
house in peace, and Yahweh will be my
God,
22 then this stone, which I have set up
for a pillar, will be God's house. Of all that
you will give me I will surely give a tenth
to you."

29

1 Then Jacob went on his journey, and
came to the land of the children of the
east.
2 He looked, and saw a well in the field,
and saw three flocks of sheep lying there
by it. For out of that well they watered the
flocks. The stone on the well's mouth was
large.
3 There all the flocks were gathered.
They rolled the stone from the well's
mouth, and watered the sheep, and put
the stone back on the well's mouth in its
place.
4 Jacob said to them, "My relatives,
where are you from?"
They said, "We are from Haran."
5 He said to them, "Do you know Laban,
the son of Nahor?"
They said, "We know him."
6 He said to them, "Is it well with him?"
They said, "It is well. See, Rachel, his
daughter, is coming with the sheep."
7 He said, "Behold, it is still the middle of
the day, not time to gather the livestock
together. Water the sheep, and go and
feed them."
8 They said, "We can't, until all the flocks
are gathered together, and they roll the
stone from the well's mouth. Then we will
water the sheep."
9 While he was yet speaking with them,
Rachel came with her father's sheep, for
she kept them.
10 When Jacob saw Rachel the daughter
of Laban, his mother's brother, and the
sheep of Laban, his mother's brother,
Jacob went near, and rolled the stone
from the well's mouth, and watered the
flock of Laban his mother's brother.
11 Jacob kissed Rachel, and lifted up his
voice, and wept.
12 Jacob told Rachel that he was her
father's relative, and that he was

Rebekah's son. She ran and told her father.
13 When Laban heard the news of Jacob, his sister's son, he ran to meet Jacob, and embraced him, and kissed him, and brought him to his house. Jacob told Laban all these things.
14 Laban said to him, "Surely you are my bone and my flesh." Jacob stayed with him for a month.
15 Laban said to Jacob, "Because you are my relative, should you therefore serve me for nothing? Tell me, what will your wages be?"
16 Laban had two daughters. The name of the elder was Leah, and the name of the younger was Rachel.
17 Leah's eyes were weak, but Rachel was beautiful in form and attractive.
18 Jacob loved Rachel. He said, "I will serve you seven years for Rachel, your younger daughter."
19 Laban said, "It is better that I give her to you, than that I should give her to another man. Stay with me."
20 Jacob served seven years for Rachel. They seemed to him but a few days, for the love he had for her.
21 Jacob said to Laban, "Give me my wife, for my days are fulfilled, that I may go in to her."
22 Laban gathered together all the men of the place, and made a feast.
23 In the evening, he took Leah his daughter, and brought her to Jacob. He went in to her.
24 Laban gave Zilpah his servant to his daughter Leah for a servant.
25 In the morning, behold, it was Leah! He said to Laban, "What is this you have done to me? Didn't I serve with you for Rachel? Why then have you deceived me?"
26 Laban said, "It is not done so in our place, to give the younger before the firstborn.
27 Fulfill the week of this one, and we will give you the other also for the service which you will serve with me for seven more years."
28 Jacob did so, and fulfilled her week. He gave him Rachel his daughter as wife.
29 Laban gave Bilhah, his servant, to his daughter Rachel to be her servant.
30 He went in also to Rachel, and he loved also Rachel more than Leah, and served with him seven more years.
31 Yahweh saw that Leah was hated, and he opened her womb, but Rachel was barren.
32 Leah conceived, and bore a son, and she named him Reuben. For she said, "Because Yahweh has looked at my affliction; for now my husband will love me."
33 She conceived again, and bore a son, and said, "Because Yahweh has heard that I am hated, he has therefore given me this son also." She named him Simeon.
34 She conceived again, and bore a son. She said, "Now this time my husband will be joined to me, because I have borne him three sons." Therefore his name was called Levi.
35 She conceived again, and bore a son. She said, "This time I will praise Yahweh." Therefore she named him Judah. Then she stopped bearing.

30

1 When Rachel saw that she bore Jacob no children, Rachel envied her sister. She said to Jacob, "Give me children, or else I will die."
2 Jacob's anger burned against Rachel, and he said, "Am I in God's place, who has withheld from you the fruit of the womb?"
3 She said, "Behold, my maid Bilhah. Go in to her, that she may bear on my knees, and I also may obtain children by her."
4 She gave him Bilhah her servant as wife, and Jacob went in to her.
5 Bilhah conceived, and bore Jacob a son.
6 Rachel said, "God has judged me, and has also heard my voice, and has given me a son." Therefore she called his name Dan.
7 Bilhah, Rachel's servant, conceived again, and bore Jacob a second son.
8 Rachel said, "I have wrestled with my sister with mighty wrestlings, and have prevailed." She named him Naphtali.
9 When Leah saw that she had finished bearing, she took Zilpah, her servant, and gave her to Jacob as a wife.

10 Zilpah, Leah's servant, bore Jacob a
son.
11 Leah said, "How fortunate!" She
named him Gad.
12 Zilpah, Leah's servant, bore Jacob a
second son.
13 Leah said, "Happy am I, for the
daughters will call me happy." She named
him Asher.
14 Reuben went in the days of wheat
harvest, and found mandrakes in the
field, and brought them to his mother,
Leah. Then Rachel said to Leah, "Please
give me some of your son's mandrakes."
15 Leah said to her, "Is it a small matter
that you have taken away my husband?
Would you take away my son's
mandrakes, also?"
Rachel said, "Therefore he will lie with
you tonight for your son's mandrakes."
16 Jacob came from the field in the
evening, and Leah went out to meet him,
and said, "You must come in to me; for I
have surely hired you with my son's
mandrakes."
He lay with her that night.
17 God listened to Leah, and she
conceived, and bore Jacob a fifth son.
18 Leah said, "God has given me my hire,
because I gave my servant to my
husband." She named him Issachar.
19 Leah conceived again, and bore a
sixth son to Jacob.
20 Leah said, "God has endowed me with
a good dowry. Now my husband will live
with me, because I have borne him six
sons." She named him Zebulun.
21 Afterwards, she bore a daughter, and
named her Dinah.
22 God remembered Rachel, and God
listened to her, and opened her womb.
23 She conceived, bore a son, and said,
"God has taken away my reproach."
24 She named him Joseph,† saying, "May
Yahweh add another son to me."
25 When Rachel had borne Joseph, Jacob
said to Laban, "Send me away, that I may
go to my own place, and to my country.
26 Give me my wives and my children
for whom I have served you, and let me
go; for you know my service with which I
have served you."
27 Laban said to him, "If now I have
found favor in your eyes, stay here, for I
have divined that Yahweh has blessed me
for your sake."
28 He said, "Appoint me your wages, and
I will give it."
29 Jacob said to him, "You know how I
have served you, and how your livestock
have fared with me.
30 For it was little which you had before
I came, and it has increased to a
multitude. Yahweh has blessed you
wherever I turned. Now when will I
provide for my own house also?"
31 Laban said, "What shall I give you?"
Jacob said, "You shall not give me
anything. If you will do this thing for me, I
will again feed your flock and keep it.
32 I will pass through all your flock
today, removing from there every
speckled and spotted one, and every black
one among the sheep, and the spotted and
speckled among the goats. This will be my
hire.
33 So my righteousness will answer for
me hereafter, when you come concerning
my hire that is before you. Every one that
is not speckled and spotted among the
goats, and black among the sheep, that
might be with me, will be considered
stolen."
34 Laban said, "Behold, let it be
according to your word."
35 That day, he removed the male goats
that were streaked and spotted, and all
the female goats that were speckled and
spotted, every one that had white in it,
and all the black ones among the sheep,
and gave them into the hand of his sons.
36 He set three days' journey between
himself and Jacob, and Jacob fed the rest
of Laban's flocks.
37 Jacob took to himself rods of fresh
poplar, almond, and plane tree, peeled
white streaks in them, and made the
white appear which was in the rods.
38 He set the rods which he had peeled
opposite the flocks in the watering
troughs where the flocks came to drink.
They conceived when they came to drink.

† **30:24** Joseph means "may he add".

39 The flocks conceived before the rods,
and the flocks produced streaked,
speckled, and spotted.
40 Jacob separated the lambs, and set the
faces of the flocks toward the streaked
and all the black in Laban's flock. He put
his own droves apart, and didn't put them
into Laban's flock.
41 Whenever the stronger of the flock
conceived, Jacob laid the rods in front of
the eyes of the flock in the watering
troughs, that they might conceive among
the rods;
42 but when the flock were feeble, he
didn't put them in. So the feebler were
Laban's, and the stronger Jacob's.
43 The man increased exceedingly, and
had large flocks, female servants and
male servants, and camels and donkeys.

31

1 Jacob heard Laban's sons' words,
saying, "Jacob has taken away all that was
our father's. He has obtained all this
wealth from that which was our father's."
2 Jacob saw the expression on Laban's
face, and, behold, it was not toward him
as before.
3 Yahweh said to Jacob, "Return to the
land of your fathers, and to your relatives,
and I will be with you."
4 Jacob sent and called Rachel and Leah
to the field to his flock,
5 and said to them, "I see the expression
on your father's face, that it is not toward
me as before; but the God of my father has
been with me.
6 You know that I have served your
father with all of my strength.
7 Your father has deceived me, and
changed my wages ten times, but God
didn't allow him to hurt me.
8 If he said, 'The speckled will be your
wages,' then all the flock bore speckled. If
he said, 'The streaked will be your wages,'
then all the flock bore streaked.
9 Thus God has taken away your father's
livestock, and given them to me.
10 During mating season, I lifted up my
eyes, and saw in a dream, and behold, the
male goats which leaped on the flock were
streaked, speckled, and grizzled.
11 The angel of God said to me in the
dream, 'Jacob,' and I said, 'Here I am.'
12 He said, 'Now lift up your eyes, and
behold, all the male goats which leap on
the flock are streaked, speckled, and
grizzled, for I have seen all that Laban
does to you.
13 I am the God of Bethel, where you
anointed a pillar, where you vowed a vow
to me. Now arise, get out from this land,
and return to the land of your birth.' "
14 Rachel and Leah answered him, "Is
there yet any portion or inheritance for us
in our father's house?
15 Aren't we considered as foreigners by
him? For he has sold us, and has also used
up our money.
16 For all the riches which God has taken
away from our father are ours and our
children's. Now then, whatever God has
said to you, do."
17 Then Jacob rose up, and set his sons
and his wives on the camels,
18 and he took away all his livestock,
and all his possessions which he had
gathered, including the livestock which
he had gained in Paddan Aram, to go to
Isaac his father, to the land of Canaan.
19 Now Laban had gone to shear his
sheep; and Rachel stole the teraphim† that
were her father's.
20 Jacob deceived Laban the Syrian, in
that he didn't tell him that he was running
away.
21 So he fled with all that he had. He
rose up, passed over the River, and set his
face toward the mountain of Gilead.
22 Laban was told on the third day that
Jacob had fled.
23 He took his relatives with him, and
pursued him seven days' journey. He
overtook him in the mountain of Gilead.
24 God came to Laban the Syrian in a
dream of the night, and said to him, "Be
careful that you don't speak to Jacob
either good or bad."
25 Laban caught up with Jacob. Now
Jacob had pitched his tent in the

† **31:19** teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

mountain, and Laban with his relatives encamped in the mountain of Gilead.
26 Laban said to Jacob, “What have you done, that you have deceived me, and carried away my daughters like captives of the sword?
27 Why did you flee secretly, and deceive me, and didn’t tell me, that I might have sent you away with mirth and with songs, with tambourine and with harp;
28 and didn’t allow me to kiss my sons and my daughters? Now you have done foolishly.
29 It is in the power of my hand to hurt you, but the God of your father spoke to me last night, saying, ‘Be careful that you don’t speak to Jacob either good or bad.’
30 Now, you want to be gone, because you greatly longed for your father’s house, but why have you stolen my gods?”

31 Jacob answered Laban, “Because I was afraid, for I said, ‘Lest you should take your daughters from me by force.’
32 Anyone you find your gods with shall not live. Before our relatives, discern what is yours with me, and take it.” For Jacob didn’t know that Rachel had stolen them.

33 Laban went into Jacob’s tent, into Leah’s tent, and into the tent of the two female servants; but he didn’t find them. He went out of Leah’s tent, and entered into Rachel’s tent.
34 Now Rachel had taken the teraphim, put them in the camel’s saddle, and sat on them. Laban felt around all the tent, but didn’t find them.
35 She said to her father, “Don’t let my lord be angry that I can’t rise up before you; for I’m having my period.” He searched, but didn’t find the teraphim.

36 Jacob was angry, and argued with Laban. Jacob answered Laban, “What is my trespass? What is my sin, that you have hotly pursued me?
37 Now that you have felt around in all my stuff, what have you found of all your household stuff? Set it here before my relatives and your relatives, that they may judge between us two.

38 “These twenty years I have been with you. Your ewes and your female goats have not cast their young, and I haven’t eaten the rams of your flocks.
39 That which was torn of animals, I didn’t bring to you. I bore its loss. Of my hand you required it, whether stolen by day or stolen by night.
40 This was my situation: in the day the drought consumed me, and the frost by night; and my sleep fled from my eyes.
41 These twenty years I have been in your house. I served you fourteen years for your two daughters, and six years for your flock, and you have changed my wages ten times.
42 Unless the God of my father, the God of Abraham, and the fear of Isaac, had been with me, surely now you would have sent me away empty. God has seen my affliction and the labor of my hands, and rebuked you last night.”

43 Laban answered Jacob, “The daughters are my daughters, the children are my children, the flocks are my flocks, and all that you see is mine! What can I do today to these my daughters, or to their children whom they have borne?
44 Now come, let’s make a covenant, you and I. Let it be for a witness between me and you.”

45 Jacob took a stone, and set it up for a pillar.
46 Jacob said to his relatives, “Gather stones.” They took stones, and made a heap. They ate there by the heap.
47 Laban called it Jegar Sahadutha,‡ but Jacob called it Galeed.§
48 Laban said, “This heap is witness between me and you today.” Therefore it was named Galeed
49 and Mizpah, for he said, “Yahweh watch between me and you, when we are absent one from another.
50 If you afflict my daughters, or if you take wives in addition to my daughters,

‡ **31:47** “Jegar Sahadutha” means “Witness Heap” in Aramaic. § **31:47** “Galeed” means “Witness Heap” in Hebrew.

no man is with us; behold, God is witness between me and you."
51 Laban said to Jacob, "See this heap, and see the pillar, which I have set between me and you.
52 May this heap be a witness, and the pillar be a witness, that I will not pass over this heap to you, and that you will not pass over this heap and this pillar to me, for harm.
53 The God of Abraham, and the God of Nahor, the God of their father, judge between us." Then Jacob swore by the fear of his father, Isaac.
54 Jacob offered a sacrifice in the mountain, and called his relatives to eat bread. They ate bread, and stayed all night in the mountain.
55 Early in the morning, Laban rose up, and kissed his sons and his daughters, and blessed them. Laban departed and returned to his place.

32

1 Jacob went on his way, and the angels of God met him.
2 When he saw them, Jacob said, "This is God's army." He called the name of that place Mahanaim.†
3 Jacob sent messengers in front of him to Esau, his brother, to the land of Seir, the field of Edom.
4 He commanded them, saying, "This is what you shall tell my lord, Esau: 'This is what your servant, Jacob, says. I have lived as a foreigner with Laban, and stayed until now.
5 I have cattle, donkeys, flocks, male servants, and female servants. I have sent to tell my lord, that I may find favor in your sight.' "
6 The messengers returned to Jacob, saying, "We came to your brother Esau. He is coming to meet you, and four hundred men are with him."
7 Then Jacob was greatly afraid and was distressed. He divided the people who were with him, along with the flocks, the herds, and the camels, into two companies.
8 He said, "If Esau comes to the one company, and strikes it, then the company which is left will escape."
9 Jacob said, "God of my father Abraham, and God of my father Isaac, Yahweh, who said to me, 'Return to your country, and to your relatives, and I will do you good,'
10 I am not worthy of the least of all the loving kindnesses, and of all the truth, which you have shown to your servant; for with just my staff I crossed over this Jordan; and now I have become two companies.
11 Please deliver me from the hand of my brother, from the hand of Esau; for I fear him, lest he come and strike me and the mothers with the children.
12 You said, 'I will surely do you good, and make your offspring as the sand of the sea, which can't be counted because there are so many.' "
13 He stayed there that night, and took from that which he had with him a present for Esau, his brother:
14 two hundred female goats and twenty male goats, two hundred ewes and twenty rams,
15 thirty milk camels and their colts, forty cows, ten bulls, twenty female donkeys and ten foals.
16 He delivered them into the hands of his servants, every herd by itself, and said to his servants, "Pass over before me, and put a space between herd and herd."
17 He commanded the foremost, saying, "When Esau, my brother, meets you, and asks you, saying, 'Whose are you? Where are you going? Whose are these before you?'
18 Then you shall say, 'They are your servant, Jacob's. It is a present sent to my lord, Esau. Behold, he also is behind us.' "
19 He commanded also the second, and the third, and all that followed the herds, saying, "This is how you shall speak to Esau, when you find him.
20 You shall say, 'Not only that, but behold, your servant, Jacob, is behind us.' " For, he said, "I will appease him with

† **32:2** "Mahanaim" means "two camps".

the present that goes before me, and
afterward I will see his face. Perhaps he
will accept me."
21 So the present passed over before
him, and he himself stayed that night in
the camp.
22 He rose up that night, and took his
two wives, and his two servants, and his
eleven sons, and crossed over the ford of
the Jabbok.
23 He took them, and sent them over the
stream, and sent over that which he had.
24 Jacob was left alone, and wrestled
with a man there until the breaking of the
day.
25 When he saw that he didn't prevail
against him, the man touched the hollow
of his thigh, and the hollow of Jacob's
thigh was strained as he wrestled.
26 The man said, "Let me go, for the day
breaks."
Jacob said, "I won't let you go unless you
bless me."
27 He said to him, "What is your name?"
He said, "Jacob".
28 He said, "Your name will no longer be
called Jacob, but Israel; for you have
fought with God and with men, and have
prevailed."
29 Jacob asked him, "Please tell me your
name."
He said, "Why is it that you ask what my
name is?" So he blessed him there.
30 Jacob called the name of the place
Peniel;‡ for he said, "I have seen God face
to face, and my life is preserved."
31 The sun rose on him as he passed over
Peniel, and he limped because of his thigh.
32 Therefore the children of Israel don't
eat the sinew of the hip, which is on the
hollow of the thigh, to this day, because he
touched the hollow of Jacob's thigh in the
sinew of the hip.

33

1 Jacob lifted up his eyes, and looked,
and, behold, Esau was coming, and with
him four hundred men. He divided the
children between Leah, Rachel, and the
two servants.
2 He put the servants and their children
in front, Leah and her children after, and
Rachel and Joseph at the rear.
3 He himself passed over in front of
them, and bowed himself to the ground
seven times, until he came near to his
brother.
4 Esau ran to meet him, embraced him,
fell on his neck, kissed him, and they wept.
5 He lifted up his eyes, and saw the
women and the children; and said, "Who
are these with you?"
He said, "The children whom God has
graciously given your servant."
6 Then the servants came near with
their children, and they bowed
themselves.
7 Leah also and her children came near,
and bowed themselves. After them,
Joseph came near with Rachel, and they
bowed themselves.
8 Esau said, "What do you mean by all
this company which I met?"
Jacob said, "To find favor in the sight of
my lord."
9 Esau said, "I have enough, my brother;
let that which you have be yours."
10 Jacob said, "Please, no, if I have now
found favor in your sight, then receive my
present at my hand, because I have seen
your face, as one sees the face of God, and
you were pleased with me.
11 Please take the gift that I brought to
you, because God has dealt graciously
with me, and because I have enough." He
urged him, and he took it.
12 Esau said, "Let's take our journey, and
let's go, and I will go before you."
13 Jacob said to him, "My lord knows
that the children are tender, and that the
flocks and herds with me have their
young, and if they overdrive them one
day, all the flocks will die.
14 Please let my lord pass over before his
servant, and I will lead on gently,
according to the pace of the livestock that
are before me and according to the pace
of the children, until I come to my lord to
Seir."
15 Esau said, "Let me now leave with
you some of the people who are with me."

‡ **32:30** Peniel means "face of God".

He said, “Why? Let me find favor in the
sight of my lord.”
16 So Esau returned that day on his way
to Seir.
17 Jacob traveled to Succoth, built
himself a house, and made shelters for his
livestock. Therefore the name of the place
is called Succoth.†
18 Jacob came in peace to the city of
Shechem, which is in the land of Canaan,
when he came from Paddan Aram; and
encamped before the city.
19 He bought the parcel of ground
where he had spread his tent, at the hand
of the children of Hamor, Shechem’s
father, for one hundred pieces of money.
20 He erected an altar there, and called
it El Elohe Israel.‡

34

1 Dinah, the daughter of Leah, whom
she bore to Jacob, went out to see the
daughters of the land.
2 Shechem the son of Hamor the Hivite,
the prince of the land, saw her. He took
her, lay with her, and humbled her.
3 His soul joined to Dinah, the daughter
of Jacob, and he loved the young lady, and
spoke kindly to the young lady.
4 Shechem spoke to his father, Hamor,
saying, “Get me this young lady as a wife.”
5 Now Jacob heard that he had defiled
Dinah, his daughter; and his sons were
with his livestock in the field. Jacob held
his peace until they came.
6 Hamor the father of Shechem went out
to Jacob to talk with him.
7 The sons of Jacob came in from the
field when they heard it. The men were
grieved, and they were very angry,
because he had done folly in Israel in
lying with Jacob’s daughter, a thing that
ought not to be done.
8 Hamor talked with them, saying, “The
soul of my son, Shechem, longs for your
daughter. Please give her to him as a wife.
9 Make marriages with us. Give your
daughters to us, and take our daughters
for yourselves.
10 You shall dwell with us, and the land
will be before you. Live and trade in it,
and get possessions in it.”
11 Shechem said to her father and to her
brothers, “Let me find favor in your eyes,
and whatever you will tell me I will give.
12 Ask me a great amount for a dowry,
and I will give whatever you ask of me,
but give me the young lady as a wife.”
13 The sons of Jacob answered Shechem
and Hamor his father with deceit when
they spoke, because he had defiled Dinah
their sister,
14 and said to them, “We can’t do this
thing, to give our sister to one who is
uncircumcised; for that is a reproach to
us.
15 Only on this condition will we
consent to you. If you will be as we are,
that every male of you be circumcised,
16 then will we give our daughters to
you; and we will take your daughters to
us, and we will dwell with you, and we
will become one people.
17 But if you will not listen to us and be
circumcised, then we will take our sister,†
and we will be gone.”
18 Their words pleased Hamor and
Shechem, Hamor’s son.
19 The young man didn’t wait to do this
thing, because he had delight in Jacob’s
daughter, and he was honored above all
the house of his father.
20 Hamor and Shechem, his son, came to
the gate of their city, and talked with the
men of their city, saying,
21 “These men are peaceful with us.
Therefore let them live in the land and
trade in it. For behold, the land is large
enough for them. Let’s take their
daughters to us for wives, and let’s give
them our daughters.
22 Only on this condition will the men
consent to us to live with us, to become
one people, if every male among us is
circumcised, as they are circumcised.
23 Won’t their livestock and their
possessions and all their animals be ours?
Only let’s give our consent to them, and
they will dwell with us.”

† **33:17** succoth means shelters or booths. ‡ **33:20** El Elohe Israel means “God, the God of Israel” or “The God of Israel is mighty”. † **34:17** Hebrew has, literally, “daughter”

24 All who went out of the gate of his city
listened to Hamor, and to Shechem his
son; and every male was circumcised, all
who went out of the gate of his city.
25 On the third day, when they were
sore, two of Jacob's sons, Simeon and Levi,
Dinah's brothers, each took his sword,
came upon the unsuspecting city, and
killed all the males.
26 They killed Hamor and Shechem, his
son, with the edge of the sword, and took
Dinah out of Shechem's house, and went
away.
27 Jacob's sons came on the dead, and
plundered the city, because they had
defiled their sister.
28 They took their flocks, their herds,
their donkeys, that which was in the city,
that which was in the field,
29 and all their wealth. They took
captive all their little ones and their
wives, and took as plunder everything
that was in the house.
30 Jacob said to Simeon and Levi, "You
have troubled me, to make me odious to
the inhabitants of the land, among the
Canaanites and the Perizzites. I am few in
number. They will gather themselves
together against me and strike me, and I
will be destroyed, I and my house."
31 They said, "Should he deal with our
sister as with a prostitute?"

35

1 God said to Jacob, "Arise, go up to
Bethel, and live there. Make there an altar
to God, who appeared to you when you
fled from the face of Esau your brother."
2 Then Jacob said to his household, and
to all who were with him, "Put away the
foreign gods that are among you, purify
yourselves, and change your garments.
3 Let's arise, and go up to Bethel. I will
make there an altar to God, who answered
me in the day of my distress, and was with
me on the way which I went."
4 They gave to Jacob all the foreign gods
which were in their hands, and the rings
which were in their ears; and Jacob hid
them under the oak which was by
Shechem.
5 They traveled, and a terror of God was
on the cities that were around them, and
they didn't pursue the sons of Jacob.
6 So Jacob came to Luz (that is, Bethel),
which is in the land of Canaan, he and all
the people who were with him.
7 He built an altar there, and called the
place El Beth El; because there God was
revealed to him, when he fled from the
face of his brother.
8 Deborah, Rebekah's nurse, died, and
she was buried below Bethel under the
oak; and its name was called Allon Bacuth.
9 God appeared to Jacob again, when he
came from Paddan Aram, and blessed
him.
10 God said to him, "Your name is Jacob.
Your name shall not be Jacob any more,
but your name will be Israel." He named
him Israel.
11 God said to him, "I am God Almighty.
Be fruitful and multiply. A nation and a
company of nations will be from you, and
kings will come out of your body.
12 The land which I gave to Abraham
and Isaac, I will give it to you, and to your
offspring after you I will give the land."
13 God went up from him in the place
where he spoke with him.
14 Jacob set up a pillar in the place
where he spoke with him, a pillar of stone.
He poured out a drink offering on it, and
poured oil on it.
15 Jacob called the name of the place
where God spoke with him "Bethel".
16 They traveled from Bethel. There was
still some distance to come to Ephrath,
and Rachel travailed. She had hard labor.
17 When she was in hard labor, the
midwife said to her, "Don't be afraid, for
now you will have another son."
18 As her soul was departing (for she
died), she named him Benoni,† but his
father named him Benjamin.‡
19 Rachel died, and was buried on the
way to Ephrath (also called Bethlehem).

† **35:18** "Benoni" means "son of my trouble". ‡ **35:18** "Benjamin" means "son of my right hand".

20 Jacob set up a pillar on her grave. The
same is the Pillar of Rachel's grave to this
day.
21 Israel traveled, and spread his tent
beyond the tower of Eder.
22 While Israel lived in that land,
Reuben went and lay with Bilhah, his
father's concubine, and Israel heard of it.
Now the sons of Jacob were twelve.
23 The sons of Leah: Reuben (Jacob's
firstborn), Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar,
and Zebulun.
24 The sons of Rachel: Joseph and
Benjamin.
25 The sons of Bilhah (Rachel's servant):
Dan and Naphtali.
26 The sons of Zilpah (Leah's servant):
Gad and Asher. These are the sons of
Jacob, who were born to him in Paddan
Aram.
27 Jacob came to Isaac his father, to
Mamre, to Kiriath Arba (which is
Hebron), where Abraham and Isaac lived
as foreigners.
28 The days of Isaac were one hundred
eighty years.
29 Isaac gave up the spirit and died, and
was gathered to his people, old and full of
days. Esau and Jacob, his sons, buried
him.

36

1 Now this is the history of the
generations of Esau (that is, Edom).
2 Esau took his wives from the
daughters of Canaan: Adah the daughter
of Elon, the Hittite; and Oholibamah the
daughter of Anah, the daughter of Zibeon,
the Hivite;
3 and Basemath, Ishmael's daughter,
sister of Nebaioth.
4 Adah bore to Esau Eliphaz. Basemath
bore Reuel.
5 Oholibamah bore Jeush, Jalam, and
Korah. These are the sons of Esau, who
were born to him in the land of Canaan.
6 Esau took his wives, his sons, his
daughters, and all the members of his
household, with his livestock, all his
animals, and all his possessions, which he
had gathered in the land of Canaan, and
went into a land away from his brother
Jacob.
7 For their substance was too great for
them to dwell together, and the land of
their travels couldn't bear them because
of their livestock.
8 Esau lived in the hill country of Seir.
Esau is Edom.
9 This is the history of the generations of
Esau the father of the Edomites in the hill
country of Seir:
10 these are the names of Esau's sons:
Eliphaz, the son of Adah, the wife of Esau;
and Reuel, the son of Basemath, the wife
of Esau.
11 The sons of Eliphaz were Teman,
Omar, Zepho, and Gatam, and Kenaz.
12 Timna was concubine to Eliphaz,
Esau's son; and she bore to Eliphaz
Amalek. These are the descendants of
Adah, Esau's wife.
13 These are the sons of Reuel: Nahath,
Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah. These
were the descendants of Basemath, Esau's
wife.
14 These were the sons of Oholibamah,
the daughter of Anah, the daughter of
Zibeon, Esau's wife: she bore to Esau
Jeush, Jalam, and Korah.
15 These are the chiefs of the sons of
Esau: the sons of Eliphaz the firstborn of
Esau: chief Teman, chief Omar, chief
Zepho, chief Kenaz,
16 chief Korah, chief Gatam, chief
Amalek. These are the chiefs who came of
Eliphaz in the land of Edom. These are the
sons of Adah.
17 These are the sons of Reuel, Esau's
son: chief Nahath, chief Zerah, chief
Shammah, chief Mizzah. These are the
chiefs who came of Reuel in the land of
Edom. These are the sons of Basemath,
Esau's wife.
18 These are the sons of Oholibamah,
Esau's wife: chief Jeush, chief Jalam, chief
Korah. These are the chiefs who came of
Oholibamah the daughter of Anah, Esau's
wife.
19 These are the sons of Esau (that is,
Edom), and these are their chiefs.
20 These are the sons of Seir the Horite,
the inhabitants of the land: Lotan, Shobal,
Zibeon, Anah,
21 Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan. These are
the chiefs who came of the Horites, the
children of Seir in the land of Edom.

22 The children of Lotan were Hori and
Heman. Lotan's sister was Timna.
23 These are the children of Shobal:
Alvan, Manahath, Ebal, Shepho, and
Onam.
24 These are the children of Zibeon:
Aiah and Anah. This is Anah who found
the hot springs in the wilderness, as he
fed the donkeys of Zibeon his father.
25 These are the children of Anah:
Dishon and Oholibamah, the daughter of
Anah.
26 These are the children of Dishon:
Hemdan, Eshban, Ithran, and Cheran.
27 These are the children of Ezer:
Bilhan, Zaavan, and Akan.
28 These are the children of Dishan: Uz
and Aran.
29 These are the chiefs who came of the
Horites: chief Lotan, chief Shobal, chief
Zibeon, chief Anah,
30 chief Dishon, chief Ezer, and chief
Dishan. These are the chiefs who came of
the Horites, according to their chiefs in
the land of Seir.
31 These are the kings who reigned in
the land of Edom, before any king reigned
over the children of Israel.
32 Bela, the son of Beor, reigned in
Edom. The name of his city was Dinhabah.
33 Bela died, and Jobab, the son of Zerah
of Bozrah, reigned in his place.
34 Jobab died, and Husham of the land
of the Temanites reigned in his place.
35 Husham died, and Hadad, the son of
Bedad, who struck Midian in the field of
Moab, reigned in his place. The name of
his city was Avith.
36 Hadad died, and Samlah of Masrekah
reigned in his place.
37 Samlah died, and Shaul of Rehoboth
by the river, reigned in his place.
38 Shaul died, and Baal Hanan the son of
Achbor reigned in his place.
39 Baal Hanan the son of Achbor died,
and Hadar reigned in his place. The name
of his city was Pau. His wife's name was
Mehetabel, the daughter of Matred, the
daughter of Mezahab.
40 These are the names of the chiefs who
came from Esau, according to their
families, after their places, and by their
names: chief Timna, chief Alvah, chief
Jetheth,
41 chief Oholibamah, chief Elah, chief
Pinon,
42 chief Kenaz, chief Teman, chief
Mibzar,
43 chief Magdiel, and chief Iram. These
are the chiefs of Edom, according to their
habitations in the land of their possession.
This is Esau, the father of the Edomites.

37

1 Jacob lived in the land of his father's
travels, in the land of Canaan.
2 This is the history of the generations of
Jacob. Joseph, being seventeen years old,
was feeding the flock with his brothers.
He was a boy with the sons of Bilhah and
Zilpah, his father's wives. Joseph brought
an evil report of them to their father.
3 Now Israel loved Joseph more than all
his children, because he was the son of his
old age, and he made him a tunic of many
colors.
4 His brothers saw that their father
loved him more than all his brothers, and
they hated him, and couldn't speak
peaceably to him.
5 Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told
it to his brothers, and they hated him all
the more.
6 He said to them, "Please hear this
dream which I have dreamed:
7 for behold, we were binding sheaves
in the field, and behold, my sheaf arose
and also stood upright; and behold, your
sheaves came around, and bowed down
to my sheaf."
8 His brothers asked him, "Will you
indeed reign over us? Will you indeed
have dominion over us?" They hated him
all the more for his dreams and for his
words.
9 He dreamed yet another dream, and
told it to his brothers, and said, "Behold, I
have dreamed yet another dream: and
behold, the sun and the moon and eleven
stars bowed down to me."
10 He told it to his father and to his
brothers. His father rebuked him, and
said to him, "What is this dream that you
have dreamed? Will I and your mother
and your brothers indeed come to bow
ourselves down to the earth before you?"

11 His brothers envied him, but his
father kept this saying in mind.
12 His brothers went to feed their
father's flock in Shechem.
13 Israel said to Joseph, "Aren't your
brothers feeding the flock in Shechem?
Come, and I will send you to them." He
said to him, "Here I am."
14 He said to him, "Go now, see whether
it is well with your brothers, and well
with the flock; and bring me word again."
So he sent him out of the valley of Hebron,
and he came to Shechem.
15 A certain man found him, and behold,
he was wandering in the field. The man
asked him, "What are you looking for?"
16 He said, "I am looking for my
brothers. Tell me, please, where they are
feeding the flock."
17 The man said, "They have left here,
for I heard them say, 'Let's go to Dothan.' "
Joseph went after his brothers, and
found them in Dothan.
18 They saw him afar off, and before he
came near to them, they conspired
against him to kill him.
19 They said to one another, "Behold,
this dreamer comes.
20 Come now therefore, and let's kill
him, and cast him into one of the pits, and
we will say, 'An evil animal has devoured
him.' We will see what will become of his
dreams."
21 Reuben heard it, and delivered him
out of their hand, and said, "Let's not take
his life."
22 Reuben said to them, "Shed no blood.
Throw him into this pit that is in the
wilderness, but lay no hand on him"—that
he might deliver him out of their hand, to
restore him to his father.
23 When Joseph came to his brothers,
they stripped Joseph of his tunic, the tunic
of many colors that was on him;
24 and they took him, and threw him
into the pit. The pit was empty. There was
no water in it.
25 They sat down to eat bread, and they
lifted up their eyes and looked, and saw a
caravan of Ishmaelites coming from
Gilead, with their camels bearing spices
and balm and myrrh, going to carry it
down to Egypt.
26 Judah said to his brothers, "What
profit is it if we kill our brother and
conceal his blood?
27 Come, and let's sell him to the
Ishmaelites, and not let our hand be on
him; for he is our brother, our flesh." His
brothers listened to him.
28 Midianites who were merchants
passed by, and they drew and lifted up
Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to
the Ishmaelites for twenty pieces of silver.
The merchants brought Joseph into Egypt.
29 Reuben returned to the pit, and saw
that Joseph wasn't in the pit; and he tore
his clothes.
30 He returned to his brothers, and said,
"The child is no more; and I, where will I
go?"
31 They took Joseph's tunic, and killed a
male goat, and dipped the tunic in the
blood.
32 They took the tunic of many colors,
and they brought it to their father, and
said, "We have found this. Examine it,
now, and see if it is your son's tunic or
not."
33 He recognized it, and said, "It is my
son's tunic. An evil animal has devoured
him. Joseph is without doubt torn in
pieces."
34 Jacob tore his clothes, and put
sackcloth on his waist, and mourned for
his son many days.
35 All his sons and all his daughters rose
up to comfort him, but he refused to be
comforted. He said, "For I will go down to
Sheol† to my son, mourning." His father
wept for him.
36 The Midianites sold him into Egypt to
Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh's, the
captain of the guard.

38

1 At that time, Judah went down from
his brothers, and visited a certain
Adullamite, whose name was Hirah.
2 There, Judah saw the daughter of a
certain Canaanite man named Shua. He
took her, and went in to her.

† **37:35** Sheol is the place of the dead.

3 She conceived, and bore a son; and he named him Er.
4 She conceived again, and bore a son; and she named him Onan.
5 She yet again bore a son, and named him Shelah. He was at Chezib when she bore him.
6 Judah took a wife for Er, his firstborn, and her name was Tamar.
7 Er, Judah's firstborn, was wicked in Yahweh's sight. So Yahweh killed him.
8 Judah said to Onan, "Go in to your brother's wife, and perform the duty of a husband's brother to her, and raise up offspring for your brother."
9 Onan knew that the offspring wouldn't be his; and when he went in to his brother's wife, he spilled his semen on the ground, lest he should give offspring to his brother.
10 The thing which he did was evil in Yahweh's sight, and he killed him also.
11 Then Judah said to Tamar, his daughter-in-law, "Remain a widow in your father's house, until Shelah, my son, is grown up;" for he said, "Lest he also die, like his brothers." Tamar went and lived in her father's house.
12 After many days, Shua's daughter, the wife of Judah, died. Judah was comforted, and went up to his sheep shearers to Timnah, he and his friend Hirah, the Adullamite.
13 Tamar was told, "Behold, your father-in-law is going up to Timnah to shear his sheep."
14 She took off the garments of her widowhood, and covered herself with her veil, and wrapped herself, and sat in the gate of Enaim, which is on the way to Timnah; for she saw that Shelah was grown up, and she wasn't given to him as a wife.
15 When Judah saw her, he thought that she was a prostitute, for she had covered her face.
16 He turned to her by the way, and said, "Please come, let me come in to you," for he didn't know that she was his daughter-in-law.

She said, "What will you give me, that you may come in to me?"

17 He said, "I will send you a young goat from the flock."

She said, "Will you give me a pledge, until you send it?"

18 He said, "What pledge will I give you?"

She said, "Your signet and your cord, and your staff that is in your hand."

He gave them to her, and came in to her, and she conceived by him.
19 She arose, and went away, and put off her veil from her, and put on the garments of her widowhood.
20 Judah sent the young goat by the hand of his friend, the Adullamite, to receive the pledge from the woman's hand, but he didn't find her.
21 Then he asked the men of her place, saying, "Where is the prostitute, that was at Enaim by the road?"

They said, "There has been no prostitute here."

22 He returned to Judah, and said, "I haven't found her; and also the men of the place said, 'There has been no prostitute here.' "
23 Judah said, "Let her keep it, lest we be shamed. Behold, I sent this young goat, and you haven't found her."
24 About three months later, Judah was told, "Tamar, your daughter-in-law, has played the prostitute. Moreover, behold, she is with child by prostitution."

Judah said, "Bring her out, and let her be burned."

25 When she was brought out, she sent to her father-in-law, saying, "I am with child by the man who owns these." She also said, "Please discern whose these are—the signet, and the cords, and the staff."
26 Judah acknowledged them, and said, "She is more righteous than I, because I didn't give her to Shelah, my son."

He knew her again no more.
27 In the time of her travail, behold, twins were in her womb.
28 When she travailed, one put out a hand, and the midwife took and tied a scarlet thread on his hand, saying, "This came out first."

29 As he drew back his hand, behold, his
brother came out, and she said, “Why
have you made a breach for yourself?”
Therefore his name was called Perez.†
30 Afterward his brother came out, who
had the scarlet thread on his hand, and
his name was called Zerah.‡

39

1 Joseph was brought down to Egypt.
Potiphar, an officer of Pharaoh’s, the
captain of the guard, an Egyptian, bought
him from the hand of the Ishmaelites that
had brought him down there.
2 Yahweh was with Joseph, and he was a
prosperous man. He was in the house of
his master the Egyptian.
3 His master saw that Yahweh was with
him, and that Yahweh made all that he did
prosper in his hand.
4 Joseph found favor in his sight. He
ministered to him, and Potiphar made
him overseer over his house, and all that
he had he put into his hand.
5 From the time that he made him
overseer in his house, and over all that he
had, Yahweh blessed the Egyptian’s house
for Joseph’s sake. Yahweh’s blessing was
on all that he had, in the house and in the
field.
6 He left all that he had in Joseph’s hand.
He didn’t concern himself with anything,
except for the food which he ate.

Joseph was well-built and handsome.
7 After these things, his master’s wife set
her eyes on Joseph; and she said, “Lie with
me.”
8 But he refused, and said to his master’s
wife, “Behold, my master doesn’t know
what is with me in the house, and he has
put all that he has into my hand.
9 No one is greater in this house than I
am, and he has not kept back anything
from me but you, because you are his
wife. How then can I do this great
wickedness, and sin against God?”
10 As she spoke to Joseph day by day, he
didn’t listen to her, to lie by her, or to be
with her.
11 About this time, he went into the
house to do his work, and there were
none of the men of the house inside.
12 She caught him by his garment,
saying, “Lie with me!”
He left his garment in her hand, and ran
outside.
13 When she saw that he had left his
garment in her hand, and had run outside,
14 she called to the men of her house,
and spoke to them, saying, “Behold, he has
brought a Hebrew in to us to mock us. He
came in to me to lie with me, and I cried
with a loud voice.
15 When he heard that I lifted up my
voice and cried, he left his garment by me,
and ran outside.”
16 She laid up his garment by her, until
his master came home.
17 She spoke to him according to these
words, saying, “The Hebrew servant,
whom you have brought to us, came in to
me to mock me,
18 and as I lifted up my voice and cried,
he left his garment by me, and ran
outside.”
19 When his master heard the words of
his wife, which she spoke to him, saying,
“This is what your servant did to me,” his
wrath was kindled.
20 Joseph’s master took him, and put
him into the prison, the place where the
king’s prisoners were bound, and he was
there in custody.
21 But Yahweh was with Joseph, and
showed kindness to him, and gave him
favor in the sight of the keeper of the
prison.
22 The keeper of the prison committed
to Joseph’s hand all the prisoners who
were in the prison. Whatever they did
there, he was responsible for it.
23 The keeper of the prison didn’t look
after anything that was under his hand,
because Yahweh was with him; and that
which he did, Yahweh made it prosper.

40

1 After these things, the butler of the
king of Egypt and his baker offended their
lord, the king of Egypt.

† **38:29** Perez means “breaking out”. ‡ **38:30** Zerah means “scarlet” or “brightness”.

2 Pharaoh was angry with his two
officers, the chief cup bearer and the chief
baker.
3 He put them in custody in the house of
the captain of the guard, into the prison,
the place where Joseph was bound.
4 The captain of the guard assigned
them to Joseph, and he took care of them.
They stayed in prison many days.
5 They both dreamed a dream, each
man his dream, in one night, each man
according to the interpretation of his
dream, the cup bearer and the baker of
the king of Egypt, who were bound in the
prison.
6 Joseph came in to them in the
morning, and saw them, and saw that
they were sad.
7 He asked Pharaoh's officers who were
with him in custody in his master's house,
saying, "Why do you look so sad today?"
8 They said to him, "We have dreamed a
dream, and there is no one who can
interpret it."
Joseph said to them, "Don't
interpretations belong to God? Please tell
it to me."
9 The chief cup bearer told his dream to
Joseph, and said to him, "In my dream,
behold, a vine was in front of me,
10 and in the vine were three branches.
It was as though it budded, it blossomed,
and its clusters produced ripe grapes.
11 Pharaoh's cup was in my hand; and I
took the grapes, and pressed them into
Pharaoh's cup, and I gave the cup into
Pharaoh's hand."
12 Joseph said to him, "This is its
interpretation: the three branches are
three days.
13 Within three more days, Pharaoh will
lift up your head, and restore you to your
office. You will give Pharaoh's cup into his
hand, the way you did when you were his
cup bearer.
14 But remember me when it is well
with you. Please show kindness to me,
and make mention of me to Pharaoh, and
bring me out of this house.
15 For indeed, I was stolen away out of
the land of the Hebrews, and here also I
have done nothing that they should put
me into the dungeon."
16 When the chief baker saw that the
interpretation was good, he said to
Joseph, "I also was in my dream, and
behold, three baskets of white bread were
on my head.
17 In the uppermost basket there were
all kinds of baked food for Pharaoh, and
the birds ate them out of the basket on my
head."
18 Joseph answered, "This is its
interpretation. The three baskets are
three days.
19 Within three more days, Pharaoh will
lift up your head from off you, and will
hang you on a tree; and the birds will eat
your flesh from off you."
20 On the third day, which was
Pharaoh's birthday, he made a feast for all
his servants, and he lifted up the head of
the chief cup bearer and the head of the
chief baker among his servants.
21 He restored the chief cup bearer to
his position again, and he gave the cup
into Pharaoh's hand;
22 but he hanged the chief baker, as
Joseph had interpreted to them.
23 Yet the chief cup bearer didn't
remember Joseph, but forgot him.

41

1 At the end of two full years, Pharaoh
dreamed, and behold, he stood by the
river.
2 Behold, seven cattle came up out of the
river. They were sleek and fat, and they
fed in the marsh grass.
3 Behold, seven other cattle came up
after them out of the river, ugly and thin,
and stood by the other cattle on the brink
of the river.
4 The ugly and thin cattle ate up the
seven sleek and fat cattle. So Pharaoh
awoke.
5 He slept and dreamed a second time;
and behold, seven heads of grain came up
on one stalk, healthy and good.
6 Behold, seven heads of grain, thin and
blasted with the east wind, sprung up
after them.

7 The thin heads of grain swallowed up
the seven healthy and full ears. Pharaoh
awoke, and behold, it was a dream.
8 In the morning, his spirit was
troubled, and he sent and called for all of
Egypt's magicians and wise men. Pharaoh
told them his dreams, but there was no
one who could interpret them to Pharaoh.

9 Then the chief cup bearer spoke to
Pharaoh, saying, "I remember my faults
today.
10 Pharaoh was angry with his servants,
and put me in custody in the house of the
captain of the guard, with the chief baker.
11 We dreamed a dream in one night, he
and I. Each man dreamed according to the
interpretation of his dream.
12 There was with us there a young man,
a Hebrew, servant to the captain of the
guard, and we told him, and he
interpreted to us our dreams. He
interpreted to each man according to his
dream.
13 As he interpreted to us, so it was. He
restored me to my office, and he hanged
him."
14 Then Pharaoh sent and called Joseph,
and they brought him hastily out of the
dungeon. He shaved himself, changed his
clothing, and came in to Pharaoh.
15 Pharaoh said to Joseph, "I have
dreamed a dream, and there is no one
who can interpret it. I have heard it said
of you, that when you hear a dream you
can interpret it."

16 Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, "It
isn't in me. God will give Pharaoh an
answer of peace."

17 Pharaoh spoke to Joseph, "In my
dream, behold, I stood on the brink of the
river;
18 and behold, seven fat and sleek cattle
came up out of the river. They fed in the
marsh grass;
19 and behold, seven other cattle came
up after them, poor and very ugly and
thin, such as I never saw in all the land of
Egypt for ugliness.
20 The thin and ugly cattle ate up the
first seven fat cattle;
21 and when they had eaten them up, it
couldn't be known that they had eaten
them, but they were still ugly, as at the
beginning. So I awoke.
22 I saw in my dream, and behold, seven
heads of grain came up on one stalk, full
and good;
23 and behold, seven heads of grain,
withered, thin, and blasted with the east
wind, sprung up after them.
24 The thin heads of grain swallowed up
the seven good heads of grain. I told it to
the magicians, but there was no one who
could explain it to me."

25 Joseph said to Pharaoh, "The dream of
Pharaoh is one. What God is about to do
he has declared to Pharaoh.
26 The seven good cattle are seven years;
and the seven good heads of grain are
seven years. The dream is one.
27 The seven thin and ugly cattle that
came up after them are seven years, and
also the seven empty heads of grain
blasted with the east wind; they will be
seven years of famine.
28 That is the thing which I have spoken
to Pharaoh. God has shown Pharaoh what
he is about to do.
29 Behold, seven years of great plenty
throughout all the land of Egypt are
coming.
30 Seven years of famine will arise after
them, and all the plenty will be forgotten
in the land of Egypt. The famine will
consume the land,
31 and the plenty will not be known in
the land by reason of that famine which
follows; for it will be very grievous.
32 The dream was doubled to Pharaoh,
because the thing is established by God,
and God will shortly bring it to pass.

33 "Now therefore let Pharaoh look for a
discreet and wise man, and set him over
the land of Egypt.
34 Let Pharaoh do this, and let him
appoint overseers over the land, and take
up the fifth part of the land of Egypt's
produce in the seven plenteous years.
35 Let them gather all the food of these
good years that come, and store grain

under the hand of Pharaoh for food in the cities, and let them keep it.
36 The food will be to supply the land against the seven years of famine, which will be in the land of Egypt; so that the land will not perish through the famine."

37 The thing was good in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of all his servants.
38 Pharaoh said to his servants, "Can we find such a one as this, a man in whom is the Spirit of God?"
39 Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Because God has shown you all of this, there is no one so discreet and wise as you.
40 You shall be over my house. All my people will be ruled according to your word. Only in the throne I will be greater than you."
41 Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Behold, I have set you over all the land of Egypt."
42 Pharaoh took off his signet ring from his hand, and put it on Joseph's hand, and arrayed him in robes of fine linen, and put a gold chain about his neck.
43 He made him ride in the second chariot which he had. They cried before him, "Bow the knee!" He set him over all the land of Egypt.
44 Pharaoh said to Joseph, "I am Pharaoh. Without you, no man shall lift up his hand or his foot in all the land of Egypt."
45 Pharaoh called Joseph's name Zaphenath-Paneah. He gave him Asenath, the daughter of Potiphera priest of On as a wife. Joseph went out over the land of Egypt.

46 Joseph was thirty years old when he stood before Pharaoh king of Egypt. Joseph went out from the presence of Pharaoh, and went throughout all the land of Egypt.
47 In the seven plenteous years the earth produced abundantly.
48 He gathered up all the food of the seven years which were in the land of Egypt, and laid up the food in the cities. He stored food in each city from the fields around that city.
49 Joseph laid up grain as the sand of the sea, very much, until he stopped counting, for it was without number.
50 To Joseph were born two sons before the year of famine came, whom Asenath, the daughter of Potiphera priest of On, bore to him.
51 Joseph called the name of the firstborn Manasseh,† "For", he said, "God has made me forget all my toil, and all my father's house."
52 The name of the second, he called Ephraim:‡ "For God has made me fruitful in the land of my affliction."

53 The seven years of plenty, that were in the land of Egypt, came to an end.
54 The seven years of famine began to come, just as Joseph had said. There was famine in all lands, but in all the land of Egypt there was bread.
55 When all the land of Egypt was famished, the people cried to Pharaoh for bread, and Pharaoh said to all the Egyptians, "Go to Joseph. What he says to you, do."
56 The famine was over all the surface of the earth. Joseph opened all the store houses, and sold to the Egyptians. The famine was severe in the land of Egypt.
57 All countries came into Egypt, to Joseph, to buy grain, because the famine was severe in all the earth.

42

1 Now Jacob saw that there was grain in Egypt, and Jacob said to his sons, "Why do you look at one another?"
2 He said, "Behold, I have heard that there is grain in Egypt. Go down there, and buy for us from there, so that we may live, and not die."
3 Joseph's ten brothers went down to buy grain from Egypt.
4 But Jacob didn't send Benjamin, Joseph's brother, with his brothers; for he said, "Lest perhaps harm happen to him."

† **41:51** "Manasseh" sounds like the Hebrew for "forget".
‡ **41:52** "Ephraim" sounds like the Hebrew for "twice fruitful".

5 The sons of Israel came to buy among
those who came, for the famine was in the
land of Canaan.
6 Joseph was the governor over the land.
It was he who sold to all the people of the
land. Joseph's brothers came, and bowed
themselves down to him with their faces
to the earth.
7 Joseph saw his brothers, and he
recognized them, but acted like a stranger
to them, and spoke roughly with them. He
said to them, "Where did you come from?"

They said, "From the land of Canaan, to
buy food."

8 Joseph recognized his brothers, but
they didn't recognize him.
9 Joseph remembered the dreams which
he dreamed about them, and said to them,
"You are spies! You have come to see the
nakedness of the land."
10 They said to him, "No, my lord, but
your servants have come to buy food.
11 We are all one man's sons; we are
honest men. Your servants are not spies."

12 He said to them, "No, but you have
come to see the nakedness of the land!"
13 They said, "We, your servants, are
twelve brothers, the sons of one man in
the land of Canaan; and behold, the
youngest is today with our father, and one
is no more."
14 Joseph said to them, "It is like I told
you, saying, 'You are spies!'
15 By this you shall be tested. By the life
of Pharaoh, you shall not go out from
here, unless your youngest brother comes
here.
16 Send one of you, and let him get your
brother, and you shall be bound, that your
words may be tested, whether there is
truth in you, or else by the life of Pharaoh
surely you are spies."
17 He put them all together into custody
for three days.

18 Joseph said to them the third day, "Do
this, and live, for I fear God.
19 If you are honest men, then let one of
your brothers be bound in your prison;
but you go, carry grain for the famine of
your houses.

20 Bring your youngest brother to me; so
will your words be verified, and you won't
die."
They did so.
21 They said to one another, "We are
certainly guilty concerning our brother, in
that we saw the distress of his soul, when
he begged us, and we wouldn't listen.
Therefore this distress has come upon us."
22 Reuben answered them, saying,
"Didn't I tell you, saying, 'Don't sin against
the child,' and you wouldn't listen?
Therefore also, behold, his blood is
required."
23 They didn't know that Joseph
understood them; for there was an
interpreter between them.
24 He turned himself away from them,
and wept. Then he returned to them, and
spoke to them, and took Simeon from
among them, and bound him before their
eyes.
25 Then Joseph gave a command to fill
their bags with grain, and to restore each
man's money into his sack, and to give
them food for the way. So it was done to
them.
26 They loaded their donkeys with their
grain, and departed from there.
27 As one of them opened his sack to
give his donkey food in the lodging place,
he saw his money. Behold, it was in the
mouth of his sack.
28 He said to his brothers, "My money is
restored! Behold, it is in my sack!" Their
hearts failed them, and they turned
trembling to one another, saying, "What is
this that God has done to us?"
29 They came to Jacob their father, to the
land of Canaan, and told him all that had
happened to them, saying,
30 "The man, the lord of the land, spoke
roughly with us, and took us for spies of
the country.
31 We said to him, 'We are honest men.
We are no spies.
32 We are twelve brothers, sons of our
father; one is no more, and the youngest is
today with our father in the land of
Canaan.'
33 The man, the lord of the land, said to
us, 'By this I will know that you are honest

men: leave one of your brothers with me, and take grain for the famine of your houses, and go your way.
34 Bring your youngest brother to me. Then I will know that you are not spies, but that you are honest men. So I will deliver your brother to you, and you shall trade in the land.' "
35 As they emptied their sacks, behold, each man's bundle of money was in his sack. When they and their father saw their bundles of money, they were afraid.
36 Jacob, their father, said to them, "You have bereaved me of my children! Joseph is no more, Simeon is no more, and you want to take Benjamin away. All these things are against me."
37 Reuben spoke to his father, saying, "Kill my two sons, if I don't bring him to you. Entrust him to my care, and I will bring him to you again."
38 He said, "My son shall not go down with you; for his brother is dead, and he only is left. If harm happens to him along the way in which you go, then you will bring down my gray hairs with sorrow to Sheol."†

43

1 The famine was severe in the land.
2 When they had eaten up the grain which they had brought out of Egypt, their father said to them, "Go again, buy us a little more food."
3 Judah spoke to him, saying, "The man solemnly warned us, saying, 'You shall not see my face, unless your brother is with you.'
4 If you'll send our brother with us, we'll go down and buy you food;
5 but if you don't send him, we won't go down, for the man said to us, 'You shall not see my face, unless your brother is with you.' "
6 Israel said, "Why did you treat me so badly, telling the man that you had another brother?"
7 They said, "The man asked directly concerning ourselves, and concerning our relatives, saying, 'Is your father still alive? Have you another brother?' We just answered his questions. Is there any way we could know that he would say, 'Bring your brother down'?"
8 Judah said to Israel, his father, "Send the boy with me, and we'll get up and go, so that we may live, and not die, both we, and you, and also our little ones.
9 I'll be collateral for him. From my hand will you require him. If I don't bring him to you, and set him before you, then let me bear the blame forever;
10 for if we hadn't delayed, surely we would have returned a second time by now."
11 Their father, Israel, said to them, "If it must be so, then do this: Take from the choice fruits of the land in your bags, and carry down a present for the man, a little balm, a little honey, spices and myrrh, nuts, and almonds;
12 and take double money in your hand, and take back the money that was returned in the mouth of your sacks. Perhaps it was an oversight.
13 Take your brother also, get up, and return to the man.
14 May God Almighty give you mercy before the man, that he may release to you your other brother and Benjamin. If I am bereaved of my children, I am bereaved."
15 The men took that present, and they took double money in their hand, and Benjamin; and got up, went down to Egypt, and stood before Joseph.
16 When Joseph saw Benjamin with them, he said to the steward of his house, "Bring the men into the house, and butcher an animal, and prepare; for the men will dine with me at noon."
17 The man did as Joseph commanded, and the man brought the men to Joseph's house.
18 The men were afraid, because they were brought to Joseph's house; and they said, "Because of the money that was returned in our sacks the first time, we're brought in; that he may seek occasion against us, attack us, and seize us as slaves, along with our donkeys."

† **42:38** Sheol is the place of the dead.

19 They came near to the steward of
Joseph's house, and they spoke to him at
the door of the house,
20 and said, "Oh, my lord, we indeed
came down the first time to buy food.
21 When we came to the lodging place,
we opened our sacks, and behold, each
man's money was in the mouth of his
sack, our money in full weight. We have
brought it back in our hand.
22 We have brought down other money
in our hand to buy food. We don't know
who put our money in our sacks."
23 He said, "Peace be to you. Don't be
afraid. Your God, and the God of your
father, has given you treasure in your
sacks. I received your money." He
brought Simeon out to them.
24 The man brought the men into
Joseph's house, and gave them water, and
they washed their feet. He gave their
donkeys fodder.
25 They prepared the present for
Joseph's coming at noon, for they heard
that they should eat bread there.
26 When Joseph came home, they
brought him the present which was in
their hand into the house, and bowed
themselves down to the earth before him.
27 He asked them of their welfare, and
said, "Is your father well, the old man of
whom you spoke? Is he yet alive?"
28 They said, "Your servant, our father,
is well. He is still alive." They bowed
down humbly.
29 He lifted up his eyes, and saw
Benjamin, his brother, his mother's son,
and said, "Is this your youngest brother,
of whom you spoke to me?" He said, "God
be gracious to you, my son."
30 Joseph hurried, for his heart yearned
over his brother; and he sought a place to
weep. He entered into his room, and wept
there.
31 He washed his face, and came out. He
controlled himself, and said, "Serve the
meal."
32 They served him by himself, and them
by themselves, and the Egyptians who ate
with him by themselves, because the
Egyptians don't eat with the Hebrews, for
that is an abomination to the Egyptians.
33 They sat before him, the firstborn
according to his birthright, and the
youngest according to his youth, and the
men marveled with one another.
34 He sent portions to them from before
him, but Benjamin's portion was five
times as much as any of theirs. They
drank, and were merry with him.

44

1 He commanded the steward of his
house, saying, "Fill the men's sacks with
food, as much as they can carry, and put
each man's money in his sack's mouth.
2 Put my cup, the silver cup, in the sack's
mouth of the youngest, with his grain
money." He did according to the word
that Joseph had spoken.
3 As soon as the morning was light, the
men were sent away, they and their
donkeys.
4 When they had gone out of the city,
and were not yet far off, Joseph said to his
steward, "Up, follow after the men. When
you overtake them, ask them, 'Why have
you rewarded evil for good?
5 Isn't this that from which my lord
drinks, and by which he indeed divines?
You have done evil in so doing.' "
6 He overtook them, and he spoke these
words to them.
7 They said to him, "Why does my lord
speak such words as these? Far be it from
your servants that they should do such a
thing!
8 Behold, the money, which we found in
our sacks' mouths, we brought again to
you out of the land of Canaan. How then
should we steal silver or gold out of your
lord's house?
9 With whomever of your servants it is
found, let him die, and we also will be my
lord's slaves."
10 He said, "Now also let it be according
to your words. He with whom it is found
will be my slave; and you will be
blameless."

11 Then they hurried, and each man
took his sack down to the ground, and
each man opened his sack.
12 He searched, beginning with the
oldest, and ending at the youngest. The
cup was found in Benjamin's sack.
13 Then they tore their clothes, and each
man loaded his donkey, and returned to
the city.
14 Judah and his brothers came to
Joseph's house, and he was still there.
They fell on the ground before him.
15 Joseph said to them, "What deed is
this that you have done? Don't you know
that such a man as I can indeed do
divination?"
16 Judah said, "What will we tell my
lord? What will we speak? How will we
clear ourselves? God has found out the
iniquity of your servants. Behold, we are
my lord's slaves, both we and he also in
whose hand the cup is found."
17 He said, "Far be it from me that I
should do so. The man in whose hand the
cup is found, he will be my slave; but as
for you, go up in peace to your father."
18 Then Judah came near to him, and
said, "Oh, my lord, please let your servant
speak a word in my lord's ears, and don't
let your anger burn against your servant;
for you are even as Pharaoh.
19 My lord asked his servants, saying,
'Have you a father, or a brother?'
20 We said to my lord, 'We have a father,
an old man, and a child of his old age, a
little one; and his brother is dead, and he
alone is left of his mother; and his father
loves him.'
21 You said to your servants, 'Bring him
down to me, that I may set my eyes on
him.'
22 We said to my lord, 'The boy can't
leave his father, for if he should leave his
father, his father would die.'
23 You said to your servants, 'Unless
your youngest brother comes down with
you, you will see my face no more.'
24 When we came up to your servant my
father, we told him the words of my lord.
25 Our father said, 'Go again and buy us
a little food.'
26 We said, 'We can't go down. If our
youngest brother is with us, then we will
go down: for we may not see the man's
face, unless our youngest brother is with
us.'
27 Your servant, my father, said to us,
'You know that my wife bore me two sons.
28 One went out from me, and I said,
"Surely he is torn in pieces;" and I haven't
seen him since.
29 If you take this one also from me, and
harm happens to him, you will bring
down my gray hairs with sorrow to
Sheol.'†
30 Now therefore when I come to your
servant my father, and the boy is not with
us; since his life is bound up in the boy's
life;
31 it will happen, when he sees that the
boy is no more, that he will die. Your
servants will bring down the gray hairs of
your servant, our father, with sorrow to
Sheol.‡
32 For your servant became collateral
for the boy to my father, saying, 'If I don't
bring him to you, then I will bear the
blame to my father forever.'
33 Now therefore, please let your
servant stay instead of the boy, my lord's
slave; and let the boy go up with his
brothers.
34 For how will I go up to my father, if
the boy isn't with me?—lest I see the evil
that will come on my father."

45

1 Then Joseph couldn't control himself
before all those who stood before him,
and he called out, "Cause everyone to go
out from me!" No one else stood with him,
while Joseph made himself known to his
brothers.
2 He wept aloud. The Egyptians heard,
and the house of Pharaoh heard.
3 Joseph said to his brothers, "I am
Joseph! Does my father still live?"

His brothers couldn't answer him; for
they were terrified at his presence.

† **44:29** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **44:31** Sheol is the place of the dead.

4 Joseph said to his brothers, “Come
near to me, please.”
They came near. He said, “I am Joseph,
your brother, whom you sold into Egypt.
5 Now don’t be grieved, nor angry with
yourselves, that you sold me here, for God
sent me before you to preserve life.
6 For these two years the famine has
been in the land, and there are yet five
years, in which there will be no plowing
and no harvest.
7 God sent me before you to preserve for
you a remnant in the earth, and to save
you alive by a great deliverance.
8 So now it wasn’t you who sent me
here, but God, and he has made me a
father to Pharaoh, lord of all his house,
and ruler over all the land of Egypt.
9 Hurry, and go up to my father, and tell
him, ‘This is what your son Joseph says,
“God has made me lord of all Egypt. Come
down to me. Don’t wait.
10 You shall dwell in the land of Goshen,
and you will be near to me, you, your
children, your children’s children, your
flocks, your herds, and all that you have.
11 There I will provide for you; for there
are yet five years of famine; lest you come
to poverty, you, and your household, and
all that you have.” ’
12 Behold, your eyes see, and the eyes of
my brother Benjamin, that it is my mouth
that speaks to you.
13 You shall tell my father of all my glory
in Egypt, and of all that you have seen.
You shall hurry and bring my father down
here.”
14 He fell on his brother Benjamin’s neck
and wept, and Benjamin wept on his neck.
15 He kissed all his brothers, and wept
on them. After that his brothers talked
with him.
16 The report of it was heard in
Pharaoh’s house, saying, “Joseph’s
brothers have come.” It pleased Pharaoh
well, and his servants.
17 Pharaoh said to Joseph, “Tell your
brothers, ‘Do this: Load your animals, and
go, travel to the land of Canaan.
18 Take your father and your
households, and come to me, and I will
give you the good of the land of Egypt, and
you will eat the fat of the land.’
19 Now you are commanded to do this:
Take wagons out of the land of Egypt for
your little ones, and for your wives, and
bring your father, and come.
20 Also, don’t concern yourselves about
your belongings, for the good of all the
land of Egypt is yours.”
21 The sons of Israel did so. Joseph gave
them wagons, according to the
commandment of Pharaoh, and gave
them provision for the way.
22 He gave each one of them changes of
clothing, but to Benjamin he gave three
hundred pieces of silver and five changes
of clothing.
23 He sent the following to his father:
ten donkeys loaded with the good things
of Egypt, and ten female donkeys loaded
with grain and bread and provision for
his father by the way.
24 So he sent his brothers away, and
they departed. He said to them, “See that
you don’t quarrel on the way.”
25 They went up out of Egypt, and came
into the land of Canaan, to Jacob their
father.
26 They told him, saying, “Joseph is still
alive, and he is ruler over all the land of
Egypt.” His heart fainted, for he didn’t
believe them.
27 They told him all the words of Joseph,
which he had said to them. When he saw
the wagons which Joseph had sent to
carry him, the spirit of Jacob, their father,
revived.
28 Israel said, “It is enough. Joseph my
son is still alive. I will go and see him
before I die.”

46

1 Israel traveled with all that he had,
and came to Beersheba, and offered
sacrifices to the God of his father, Isaac.
2 God spoke to Israel in the visions of the
night, and said, “Jacob, Jacob!”
He said, “Here I am.”
3 He said, “I am God, the God of your
father. Don’t be afraid to go down into
Egypt, for there I will make of you a great
nation.

4 I will go down with you into Egypt. I
will also surely bring you up again.
Joseph's hand will close your eyes."
5 Jacob rose up from Beersheba, and the
sons of Israel carried Jacob, their father,
their little ones, and their wives, in the
wagons which Pharaoh had sent to carry
him.
6 They took their livestock, and their
goods, which they had gotten in the land
of Canaan, and came into Egypt—Jacob,
and all his offspring with him,
7 his sons, and his sons' sons with him,
his daughters, and his sons' daughters,
and he brought all his offspring with him
into Egypt.
8 These are the names of the children of
Israel, who came into Egypt, Jacob and his
sons: Reuben, Jacob's firstborn.
9 The sons of Reuben: Hanoch, Pallu,
Hezron, and Carmi.
10 The sons of Simeon: Jemuel, Jamin,
Ohad, Jachin, Zohar, and Shaul the son of
a Canaanite woman.
11 The sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath,
and Merari.
12 The sons of Judah: Er, Onan, Shelah,
Perez, and Zerah; but Er and Onan died in
the land of Canaan. The sons of Perez
were Hezron and Hamul.
13 The sons of Issachar: Tola, Puvah, Iob,
and Shimron.
14 The sons of Zebulun: Sered, Elon, and
Jahleel.
15 These are the sons of Leah, whom she
bore to Jacob in Paddan Aram, with his
daughter Dinah. All the souls of his sons
and his daughters were thirty-three.
16 The sons of Gad: Ziphion, Haggi,
Shuni, Ezbon, Eri, Arodi, and Areli.
17 The sons of Asher: Imnah, Ishvah,
Ishvi, Beriah, and Serah their sister. The
sons of Beriah: Heber and Malchiel.
18 These are the sons of Zilpah, whom
Laban gave to Leah, his daughter, and
these she bore to Jacob, even sixteen souls.
19 The sons of Rachel, Jacob's wife:
Joseph and Benjamin.
20 To Joseph in the land of Egypt were
born Manasseh and Ephraim, whom
Asenath, the daughter of Potiphera, priest
of On, bore to him.
21 The sons of Benjamin: Bela, Becher,
Ashbel, Gera, Naaman, Ehi, Rosh,
Muppim, Huppim, and Ard.
22 These are the sons of Rachel, who
were born to Jacob: all the souls were
fourteen.
23 The son of Dan: Hushim.
24 The sons of Naphtali: Jahzeel, Guni,
Jezer, and Shillem.
25 These are the sons of Bilhah, whom
Laban gave to Rachel, his daughter, and
these she bore to Jacob: all the souls were
seven.
26 All the souls who came with Jacob
into Egypt, who were his direct offspring,
in addition to Jacob's sons' wives, all the
souls were sixty-six.
27 The sons of Joseph, who were born to
him in Egypt, were two souls. All the souls
of the house of Jacob, who came into
Egypt, were seventy.
28 Jacob sent Judah before him to
Joseph, to show the way before him to
Goshen, and they came into the land of
Goshen.
29 Joseph prepared his chariot, and went
up to meet Israel, his father, in Goshen. He
presented himself to him, and fell on his
neck, and wept on his neck a good while.
30 Israel said to Joseph, "Now let me die,
since I have seen your face, that you are
still alive."
31 Joseph said to his brothers, and to his
father's house, "I will go up, and speak
with Pharaoh, and will tell him, 'My
brothers, and my father's house, who
were in the land of Canaan, have come to
me.
32 These men are shepherds, for they
have been keepers of livestock, and they
have brought their flocks, and their herds,
and all that they have.'
33 It will happen, when Pharaoh
summons you, and will say, 'What is your
occupation?'
34 that you shall say, 'Your servants have
been keepers of livestock from our youth
even until now, both we, and our fathers:'
that you may dwell in the land of Goshen;
for every shepherd is an abomination to
the Egyptians."

47

1 Then Joseph went in and told Pharaoh,
and said, “My father and my brothers,
with their flocks, their herds, and all that
they own, have come out of the land of
Canaan; and behold, they are in the land
of Goshen.”
2 From among his brothers he took five
men, and presented them to Pharaoh.
3 Pharaoh said to his brothers, “What is
your occupation?”

They said to Pharaoh, “Your servants
are shepherds, both we, and our fathers.”
4 They also said to Pharaoh, “We have
come to live as foreigners in the land, for
there is no pasture for your servants’
flocks. For the famine is severe in the land
of Canaan. Now therefore, please let your
servants dwell in the land of Goshen.”
5 Pharaoh spoke to Joseph, saying, “Your
father and your brothers have come to
you.
6 The land of Egypt is before you. Make
your father and your brothers dwell in
the best of the land. Let them dwell in the
land of Goshen. If you know any able men
among them, then put them in charge of
my livestock.”
7 Joseph brought in Jacob, his father,
and set him before Pharaoh; and Jacob
blessed Pharaoh.
8 Pharaoh said to Jacob, “How old are
you?”
9 Jacob said to Pharaoh, “The years of
my pilgrimage are one hundred thirty
years. The days of the years of my life
have been few and evil. They have not
attained to the days of the years of the life
of my fathers in the days of their
pilgrimage.”
10 Jacob blessed Pharaoh, and went out
from the presence of Pharaoh.
11 Joseph placed his father and his
brothers, and gave them a possession in
the land of Egypt, in the best of the land,
in the land of Rameses, as Pharaoh had
commanded.
12 Joseph provided his father, his
brothers, and all of his father’s household
with bread, according to the sizes of their
families.
13 There was no bread in all the land; for
the famine was very severe, so that the
land of Egypt and the land of Canaan
fainted by reason of the famine.
14 Joseph gathered up all the money that
was found in the land of Egypt, and in the
land of Canaan, for the grain which they
bought: and Joseph brought the money
into Pharaoh’s house.
15 When the money was all spent in the
land of Egypt, and in the land of Canaan,
all the Egyptians came to Joseph, and said,
“Give us bread, for why should we die in
your presence? For our money fails.”
16 Joseph said, “Give me your livestock;
and I will give you food for your livestock,
if your money is gone.”
17 They brought their livestock to
Joseph, and Joseph gave them bread in
exchange for the horses, and for the
flocks, and for the herds, and for the
donkeys: and he fed them with bread in
exchange for all their livestock for that
year.
18 When that year was ended, they came
to him the second year, and said to him,
“We will not hide from my lord how our
money is all spent, and the herds of
livestock are my lord’s. There is nothing
left in the sight of my lord, but our bodies,
and our lands.
19 Why should we die before your eyes,
both we and our land? Buy us and our
land for bread, and we and our land will
be servants to Pharaoh. Give us seed, that
we may live, and not die, and that the land
won’t be desolate.”
20 So Joseph bought all the land of Egypt
for Pharaoh, for every man of the
Egyptians sold his field, because the
famine was severe on them, and the land
became Pharaoh’s.
21 As for the people, he moved them to
the cities from one end of the border of
Egypt even to the other end of it.
22 Only he didn’t buy the land of the
priests, for the priests had a portion from
Pharaoh, and ate their portion which
Pharaoh gave them. That is why they
didn’t sell their land.
23 Then Joseph said to the people,
“Behold, I have bought you and your land

today for Pharaoh. Behold, here is seed
for you, and you shall sow the land.
24 It will happen at the harvests, that
you shall give a fifth to Pharaoh, and four
parts will be your own, for seed of the
field, for your food, for them of your
households, and for food for your little
ones."
25 They said, "You have saved our lives!
Let us find favor in the sight of my lord,
and we will be Pharaoh's servants."
26 Joseph made it a statute concerning
the land of Egypt to this day, that Pharaoh
should have the fifth. Only the land of the
priests alone didn't become Pharaoh's.
27 Israel lived in the land of Egypt, in the
land of Goshen; and they got themselves
possessions therein, and were fruitful,
and multiplied exceedingly.
28 Jacob lived in the land of Egypt
seventeen years. So the days of Jacob, the
years of his life, were one hundred
forty-seven years.
29 The time came near that Israel must
die, and he called his son Joseph, and said
to him, "If now I have found favor in your
sight, please put your hand under my
thigh, and deal kindly and truly with me.
Please don't bury me in Egypt,
30 but when I sleep with my fathers, you
shall carry me out of Egypt, and bury me
in their burying place."
Joseph said, "I will do as you have said."
31 Israel said, "Swear to me," and he
swore to him. Then Israel bowed himself
on the bed's head.

48

1 After these things, someone said to
Joseph, "Behold, your father is sick." He
took with him his two sons, Manasseh and
Ephraim.
2 Someone told Jacob, and said, "Behold,
your son Joseph comes to you," and Israel
strengthened himself, and sat on the bed.
3 Jacob said to Joseph, "God Almighty
appeared to me at Luz in the land of
Canaan, and blessed me,
4 and said to me, 'Behold, I will make
you fruitful, and multiply you, and I will
make of you a company of peoples, and
will give this land to your offspring after
you for an everlasting possession.'
5 Now your two sons, who were born to
you in the land of Egypt before I came to
you into Egypt, are mine; Ephraim and
Manasseh, even as Reuben and Simeon,
will be mine.
6 Your offspring, whom you become the
father of after them, will be yours. They
will be called after the name of their
brothers in their inheritance.
7 As for me, when I came from Paddan,
Rachel died beside me in the land of
Canaan on the way, when there was still
some distance to come to Ephrath, and I
buried her there on the way to Ephrath
(also called Bethlehem)."
8 Israel saw Joseph's sons, and said,
"Who are these?"
9 Joseph said to his father, "They are my
sons, whom God has given me here."
He said, "Please bring them to me, and I
will bless them."
10 Now the eyes of Israel were dim for
age, so that he couldn't see well. Joseph
brought them near to him; and he kissed
them, and embraced them.
11 Israel said to Joseph, "I didn't think I
would see your face, and behold, God has
let me see your offspring also."
12 Joseph brought them out from
between his knees, and he bowed himself
with his face to the earth.
13 Joseph took them both, Ephraim in his
right hand toward Israel's left hand, and
Manasseh in his left hand toward Israel's
right hand, and brought them near to him.
14 Israel stretched out his right hand,
and laid it on Ephraim's head, who was
the younger, and his left hand on
Manasseh's head, guiding his hands
knowingly, for Manasseh was the
firstborn.
15 He blessed Joseph, and said,

"The God before whom my fathers
Abraham and Isaac walked,
the God who has fed me all my life long to
this day,
16 the angel who has redeemed me from
all evil, bless the lads,
and let my name be named on them,

and the name of my fathers Abraham and
Isaac.
Let them grow into a multitude upon the
earth."
17 When Joseph saw that his father laid
his right hand on the head of Ephraim, it
displeased him. He held up his father's
hand, to remove it from Ephraim's head
to Manasseh's head.
18 Joseph said to his father, "Not so, my
father, for this is the firstborn. Put your
right hand on his head."
19 His father refused, and said, "I know,
my son, I know. He also will become a
people, and he also will be great.
However, his younger brother will be
greater than he, and his offspring will
become a multitude of nations."
20 He blessed them that day, saying,
"Israel will bless in your name, saying,
'God make you as Ephraim and as
Manasseh' " He set Ephraim before
Manasseh.
21 Israel said to Joseph, "Behold, I am
dying, but God will be with you, and bring
you again to the land of your fathers.
22 Moreover I have given to you one
portion above your brothers, which I took
out of the hand of the Amorite with my
sword and with my bow."

49

1 Jacob called to his sons, and said:
"Gather yourselves together, that I may
tell you that which will happen to you in
the days to come.
2 Assemble yourselves, and hear, you sons
of Jacob.
Listen to Israel, your father.

3 "Reuben, you are my firstborn, my
might, and the beginning of my
strength,
excelling in dignity, and excelling in
power.
4 Boiling over like water, you shall not
excel,
because you went up to your father's
bed,
then defiled it. He went up to my
couch.

5 "Simeon and Levi are brothers.
Their swords are weapons of
violence.
6 My soul, don't come into their council.
My glory, don't be united to their
assembly;
for in their anger they killed men.
In their self-will they hamstrung
cattle.
7 Cursed be their anger, for it was fierce;
and their wrath, for it was cruel.
I will divide them in Jacob,
and scatter them in Israel.

8 "Judah, your brothers will praise you.
Your hand will be on the neck of your
enemies.
Your father's sons will bow down
before you.
9 Judah is a lion's cub.
From the prey, my son, you have gone
up.
He stooped down, he crouched as a lion,
as a lioness.
Who will rouse him up?
10 The scepter will not depart from Judah,
nor the ruler's staff from between his
feet,
until he comes to whom it belongs.
The obedience of the peoples will be
to him.
11 Binding his foal to the vine,
his donkey's colt to the choice vine,
he has washed his garments in wine,
his robes in the blood of grapes.
12 His eyes will be red with wine,
his teeth white with milk.

13 "Zebulun will dwell at the haven of the
sea.
He will be for a haven of ships.
His border will be on Sidon.

14 "Issachar is a strong donkey,
lying down between the saddlebags.
15 He saw a resting place, that it was good,
the land, that it was pleasant.
He bows his shoulder to the burden,
and becomes a servant doing forced
labor.

16 "Dan will judge his people,
as one of the tribes of Israel.
17 Dan will be a serpent on the trail,

an adder in the path,
that bites the horse's heels,
so that his rider falls backward.
18 I have waited for your salvation,
Yahweh.

19 "A troop will press on Gad,
but he will press on their heel.

20 "Asher's food will be rich.
He will produce royal dainties.

21 "Naphtali is a doe set free,
who bears beautiful fawns.

22 "Joseph is a fruitful vine,
a fruitful vine by a spring.
His branches run over the wall.
23 The archers have severely grieved him,
shot at him, and persecuted him:
24 But his bow remained strong.
The arms of his hands were made strong,
by the hands of the Mighty One of Jacob,
(from there is the shepherd, the stone of Israel),
25 even by the God of your father, who will help you,
by the Almighty, who will bless you,
with blessings of heaven above,
blessings of the deep that lies below,
blessings of the breasts, and of the womb.
26 The blessings of your father have prevailed above the blessings of my ancestors,
above the boundaries of the ancient hills.
They will be on the head of Joseph,
on the crown of the head of him who is separated from his brothers.

27 "Benjamin is a ravenous wolf.
In the morning he will devour the prey.
At evening he will divide the plunder."
28 All these are the twelve tribes of Israel, and this is what their father spoke to them, and blessed them. He blessed everyone according to his own blessing.
29 He instructed them, and said to them, "I am to be gathered to my people. Bury me with my fathers in the cave that is in the field of Ephron the Hittite,
30 in the cave that is in the field of Machpelah, which is before Mamre, in the land of Canaan, which Abraham bought with the field from Ephron the Hittite as a burial place.
31 There they buried Abraham and Sarah, his wife. There they buried Isaac and Rebekah, his wife, and there I buried Leah:
32 the field and the cave that is therein, which was purchased from the children of Heth."
33 When Jacob finished charging his sons, he gathered up his feet into the bed, breathed his last breath, and was gathered to his people.

50

1 Joseph fell on his father's face, wept on him, and kissed him.
2 Joseph commanded his servants, the physicians, to embalm his father; and the physicians embalmed Israel.
3 Forty days were used for him, for that is how many days it takes to embalm. The Egyptians wept for Israel for seventy days.
4 When the days of weeping for him were past, Joseph spoke to Pharaoh's staff, saying, "If now I have found favor in your eyes, please speak in the ears of Pharaoh, saying,
5 'My father made me swear, saying, "Behold, I am dying. Bury me in my grave which I have dug for myself in the land of Canaan." Now therefore, please let me go up and bury my father, and I will come again.' "
6 Pharaoh said, "Go up, and bury your father, just like he made you swear."
7 Joseph went up to bury his father; and with him went up all the servants of Pharaoh, the elders of his house, all the elders of the land of Egypt,
8 all the house of Joseph, his brothers, and his father's house. Only their little ones, their flocks, and their herds, they left in the land of Goshen.
9 Both chariots and horsemen went up with him. It was a very great company.

10 They came to the threshing floor of
Atad, which is beyond the Jordan, and
there they lamented with a very great and
severe lamentation. He mourned for his
father seven days.
11 When the inhabitants of the land, the
Canaanites, saw the mourning in the floor
of Atad, they said, “This is a grievous
mourning by the Egyptians.” Therefore its
name was called Abel Mizraim, which is
beyond the Jordan.
12 His sons did to him just as he
commanded them,
13 for his sons carried him into the land
of Canaan, and buried him in the cave of
the field of Machpelah, which Abraham
bought with the field, as a possession for a
burial site, from Ephron the Hittite, near
Mamre.
14 Joseph returned into Egypt—he, and
his brothers, and all that went up with
him to bury his father, after he had buried
his father.
15 When Joseph’s brothers saw that their
father was dead, they said, “It may be that
Joseph will hate us, and will fully pay us
back for all the evil which we did to him.”
16 They sent a message to Joseph, saying,
“Your father commanded before he died,
saying,
17 ‘You shall tell Joseph, “Now please
forgive the disobedience of your brothers,
and their sin, because they did evil to
you.” ’ Now, please forgive the
disobedience of the servants of the God of
your father.” Joseph wept when they
spoke to him.
18 His brothers also went and fell down
before his face; and they said, “Behold, we
are your servants.”
19 Joseph said to them, “Don’t be afraid,
for am I in the place of God?
20 As for you, you meant evil against me,
but God meant it for good, to save many
people alive, as is happening today.
21 Now therefore don’t be afraid. I will
provide for you and your little ones.” He
comforted them, and spoke kindly to
them.
22 Joseph lived in Egypt, he, and his
father’s house. Joseph lived one hundred
ten years.
23 Joseph saw Ephraim’s children to the
third generation. The children also of
Machir, the son of Manasseh, were born
on Joseph’s knees.
24 Joseph said to his brothers, “I am
dying, but God will surely visit you, and
bring you up out of this land to the land
which he swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and
to Jacob.”
25 Joseph took an oath from the children
of Israel, saying, “God will surely visit you,
and you shall carry up my bones from
here.”
26 So Joseph died, being one hundred
ten years old, and they embalmed him,
and he was put in a coffin in Egypt.

The Second Book of Moses, Commonly Called Exodus

1 Now these are the names of the sons of
Israel, who came into Egypt (every man
and his household came with Jacob):
2 Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah,
3 Issachar, Zebulun, and Benjamin,
4 Dan and Naphtali, Gad and Asher.
5 All the souls who came out of Jacob's
body were seventy souls, and Joseph was
in Egypt already.
6 Joseph died, as did all his brothers, and
all that generation.
7 The children of Israel were fruitful,
and increased abundantly, and
multiplied, and grew exceedingly mighty;
and the land was filled with them.
8 Now there arose a new king over
Egypt, who didn't know Joseph.
9 He said to his people, "Behold,† the
people of the children of Israel are more
and mightier than we.
10 Come, let's deal wisely with them, lest
they multiply, and it happen that when
any war breaks out, they also join
themselves to our enemies and fight
against us, and escape out of the land."
11 Therefore they set taskmasters over
them to afflict them with their burdens.
They built storage cities for Pharaoh:
Pithom and Raamses.
12 But the more they afflicted them, the
more they multiplied and the more they
spread out. They started to dread the
children of Israel.
13 The Egyptians ruthlessly made the
children of Israel serve,
14 and they made their lives bitter with
hard service in mortar and in brick, and
in all kinds of service in the field, all their
service, in which they ruthlessly made
them serve.
15 The king of Egypt spoke to the
Hebrew midwives, of whom the name of
the one was Shiphrah, and the name of
the other Puah,
16 and he said, "When you perform the
duty of a midwife to the Hebrew women,
and see them on the birth stool, if it is a
son, then you shall kill him; but if it is a
daughter, then she shall live."
17 But the midwives feared God,‡ and
didn't do what the king of Egypt
commanded them, but saved the baby
boys alive.
18 The king of Egypt called for the
midwives, and said to them, "Why have
you done this thing and saved the boys
alive?"
19 The midwives said to Pharaoh,
"Because the Hebrew women aren't like
the Egyptian women; for they are
vigorous and give birth before the
midwife comes to them."
20 God dealt well with the midwives,
and the people multiplied, and grew very
mighty.
21 Because the midwives feared God, he
gave them families.
22 Pharaoh commanded all his people,
saying, "You shall cast every son who is
born into the river, and every daughter
you shall save alive."

2

1 A man of the house of Levi went and
took a daughter of Levi as his wife.
2 The woman conceived and bore a son.
When she saw that he was a fine child, she
hid him three months.
3 When she could no longer hide him,
she took a papyrus basket for him, and
coated it with tar and with pitch. She put
the child in it, and laid it in the reeds by
the river's bank.
4 His sister stood far off, to see what
would be done to him.
5 Pharaoh's daughter came down to
bathe at the river. Her maidens walked
along by the riverside. She saw the basket
among the reeds, and sent her servant to
get it.
6 She opened it, and saw the child, and
behold, the baby cried. She had

† **1:9** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

‡ **1:17** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

compassion on him, and said, “This is one of the Hebrews’ children.”

7 Then his sister said to Pharaoh’s daughter, “Should I go and call a nurse for you from the Hebrew women, that she may nurse the child for you?”

8 Pharaoh’s daughter said to her, “Go.”

The young woman went and called the child’s mother.

9 Pharaoh’s daughter said to her, “Take this child away, and nurse him for me, and I will give you your wages.”

The woman took the child, and nursed him.

10 The child grew, and she brought him to Pharaoh’s daughter, and he became her son. She named him Moses,† and said, “Because I drew him out of the water.”

11 In those days, when Moses had grown up, he went out to his brothers and saw their burdens. He saw an Egyptian striking a Hebrew, one of his brothers.

12 He looked this way and that way, and when he saw that there was no one, he killed the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand.

13 He went out the second day, and behold, two men of the Hebrews were fighting with each other. He said to him who did the wrong, “Why do you strike your fellow?”

14 He said, “Who made you a prince and a judge over us? Do you plan to kill me, as you killed the Egyptian?”

Moses was afraid, and said, “Surely this thing is known.”

15 Now when Pharaoh heard this thing, he sought to kill Moses. But Moses fled from the face of Pharaoh, and lived in the land of Midian, and he sat down by a well.

16 Now the priest of Midian had seven daughters. They came and drew water, and filled the troughs to water their father’s flock.

17 The shepherds came and drove them away; but Moses stood up and helped them, and watered their flock.

18 When they came to Reuel, their father, he said, “How is it that you have returned so early today?”

19 They said, “An Egyptian delivered us out of the hand of the shepherds, and moreover he drew water for us, and watered the flock.”

20 He said to his daughters, “Where is he? Why is it that you have left the man? Call him, that he may eat bread.”

21 Moses was content to dwell with the man. He gave Moses Zipporah, his daughter.

22 She bore a son, and he named him Gershom,‡ for he said, “I have lived as a foreigner in a foreign land.”

23 In the course of those many days, the king of Egypt died, and the children of Israel sighed because of the bondage, and they cried, and their cry came up to God because of the bondage.

24 God heard their groaning, and God remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob.

25 God saw the children of Israel, and God understood.

3

1 Now Moses was keeping the flock of Jethro, his father-in-law, the priest of Midian, and he led the flock to the back of the wilderness, and came to God’s mountain, to Horeb.

2 Yahweh’s† angel appeared to him in a flame of fire out of the middle of a bush. He looked, and behold, the bush burned with fire, and the bush was not consumed.

3 Moses said, “I will go now, and see this great sight, why the bush is not burned.”

4 When Yahweh saw that he came over to see, God called to him out of the middle of the bush, and said, “Moses! Moses!”

He said, “Here I am.”

5 He said, “Don’t come close. Take off your sandals, for the place you are standing on is holy ground.”

6 Moreover he said, “I am the God of your father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob.”

† **2:10** “Moses” sounds like the Hebrew for “draw out”. ‡ **2:22** “Gershom” sounds like the Hebrew for “an alien there”. † **3:2** “Yahweh” is God’s proper Name, sometimes rendered “LORD” (all caps) in other translations.

Moses hid his face because he was afraid to look at God.
7 Yahweh said, “I have surely seen the affliction of my people who are in Egypt, and have heard their cry because of their taskmasters, for I know their sorrows.
8 I have come down to deliver them out of the hand of the Egyptians, and to bring them up out of that land to a good and large land, to a land flowing with milk and honey; to the place of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite.
9 Now, behold, the cry of the children of Israel has come to me. Moreover I have seen the oppression with which the Egyptians oppress them.
10 Come now therefore, and I will send you to Pharaoh, that you may bring my people, the children of Israel, out of Egypt.”
11 Moses said to God, “Who am I, that I should go to Pharaoh, and that I should bring the children of Israel out of Egypt?”
12 He said, “Certainly I will be with you. This will be the token to you, that I have sent you: when you have brought the people out of Egypt, you shall serve God on this mountain.”
13 Moses said to God, “Behold, when I come to the children of Israel, and tell them, ‘The God of your fathers has sent me to you,’ and they ask me, ‘What is his name?’ what should I tell them?”
14 God said to Moses, “I AM WHO I AM,” and he said, “You shall tell the children of Israel this: ‘I AM has sent me to you.’ ”
15 God said moreover to Moses, “You shall tell the children of Israel this, ‘Yahweh, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has sent me to you.’ This is my name forever, and this is my memorial to all generations.
16 Go and gather the elders of Israel together, and tell them, ‘Yahweh, the God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Jacob, has appeared to me, saying, “I have surely visited you, and seen that which is done to you in Egypt.
17 I have said, I will bring you up out of the affliction of Egypt to the land of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, to a land flowing with milk and honey.” ’
18 They will listen to your voice. You shall come, you and the elders of Israel, to the king of Egypt, and you shall tell him, ‘Yahweh, the God of the Hebrews, has met with us. Now please let us go three days’ journey into the wilderness, that we may sacrifice to Yahweh, our God.’
19 I know that the king of Egypt won’t give you permission to go, no, not by a mighty hand.
20 I will reach out my hand and strike Egypt with all my wonders which I will do among them, and after that he will let you go.
21 I will give this people favor in the sight of the Egyptians, and it will happen that when you go, you shall not go empty-handed.
22 But every woman shall ask of her neighbor, and of her who visits her house, jewels of silver, jewels of gold, and clothing. You shall put them on your sons, and on your daughters. You shall plunder the Egyptians.”

4

1 Moses answered, “But, behold, they will not believe me, nor listen to my voice; for they will say, ‘Yahweh has not appeared to you.’ ”
2 Yahweh said to him, “What is that in your hand?”
He said, “A rod.”
3 He said, “Throw it on the ground.”
He threw it on the ground, and it became a snake; and Moses ran away from it.
4 Yahweh said to Moses, “Stretch out your hand, and take it by the tail.”
He stretched out his hand, and took hold of it, and it became a rod in his hand.
5 “This is so that they may believe that Yahweh, the God of their fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, has appeared to you.”
6 Yahweh said furthermore to him, “Now put your hand inside your cloak.”

He put his hand inside his cloak, and when he took it out, behold, his hand was leprous, as white as snow.
7 He said, “Put your hand inside your cloak again.”
He put his hand inside his cloak again, and when he took it out of his cloak, behold, it had turned again as his other flesh.
8 “It will happen, if they will not believe you or listen to the voice of the first sign, that they will believe the voice of the latter sign.
9 It will happen, if they will not believe even these two signs or listen to your voice, that you shall take of the water of the river, and pour it on the dry land. The water which you take out of the river will become blood on the dry land.”
10 Moses said to Yahweh, “O Lord,† I am not eloquent, neither before now, nor since you have spoken to your servant; for I am slow of speech, and of a slow tongue.”
11 Yahweh said to him, “Who made man’s mouth? Or who makes one mute, or deaf, or seeing, or blind? Isn’t it I, Yahweh?
12 Now therefore go, and I will be with your mouth, and teach you what you shall speak.”
13 Moses said, “Oh, Lord, please send someone else.”
14 Yahweh’s anger burned against Moses, and he said, “What about Aaron, your brother, the Levite? I know that he can speak well. Also, behold, he is coming out to meet you. When he sees you, he will be glad in his heart.
15 You shall speak to him, and put the words in his mouth. I will be with your mouth, and with his mouth, and will teach you what you shall do.
16 He will be your spokesman to the people. It will happen that he will be to you a mouth, and you will be to him as God.
17 You shall take this rod in your hand, with which you shall do the signs.”
18 Moses went and returned to Jethro his father-in-law, and said to him, “Please let me go and return to my brothers who are in Egypt, and see whether they are still alive.”
Jethro said to Moses, “Go in peace.”
19 Yahweh said to Moses in Midian, “Go, return into Egypt; for all the men who sought your life are dead.”
20 Moses took his wife and his sons, and set them on a donkey, and he returned to the land of Egypt. Moses took God’s rod in his hand.
21 Yahweh said to Moses, “When you go back into Egypt, see that you do before Pharaoh all the wonders which I have put in your hand, but I will harden his heart and he will not let the people go.
22 You shall tell Pharaoh, ‘Yahweh says, Israel is my son, my firstborn,
23 and I have said to you, “Let my son go, that he may serve me;” and you have refused to let him go. Behold, I will kill your firstborn son.’ ”
24 On the way at a lodging place, Yahweh met Moses and wanted to kill him.
25 Then Zipporah took a flint, and cut off the foreskin of her son, and cast it at his feet; and she said, “Surely you are a bridegroom of blood to me.”
26 So he let him alone. Then she said, “You are a bridegroom of blood,” because of the circumcision.
27 Yahweh said to Aaron, “Go into the wilderness to meet Moses.”
He went, and met him on God’s mountain, and kissed him.
28 Moses told Aaron all Yahweh’s words with which he had sent him, and all the signs with which he had instructed him.
29 Moses and Aaron went and gathered together all the elders of the children of Israel.
30 Aaron spoke all the words which Yahweh had spoken to Moses, and did the signs in the sight of the people.
31 The people believed, and when they heard that Yahweh had visited the children of Israel, and that he had seen their affliction, then they bowed their heads and worshiped.

† **4:10** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai”.

5

1 Afterward Moses and Aaron came,
and said to Pharaoh, “This is what
Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, ‘Let my
people go, that they may hold a feast to me
in the wilderness.’ ”
2 Pharaoh said, “Who is Yahweh, that I
should listen to his voice to let Israel go? I
don’t know Yahweh, and moreover I will
not let Israel go.”
3 They said, “The God of the Hebrews
has met with us. Please let us go three
days’ journey into the wilderness, and
sacrifice to Yahweh, our God, lest he fall
on us with pestilence, or with the sword.”
4 The king of Egypt said to them, “Why
do you, Moses and Aaron, take the people
from their work? Get back to your
burdens!”
5 Pharaoh said, “Behold, the people of
the land are now many, and you make
them rest from their burdens.”
6 The same day Pharaoh commanded
the taskmasters of the people and their
officers, saying,
7 “You shall no longer give the people
straw to make brick, as before. Let them
go and gather straw for themselves.
8 You shall require from them the
number of the bricks which they made
before. You shall not diminish anything of
it, for they are idle. Therefore they cry,
saying, ‘Let’s go and sacrifice to our God.’
9 Let heavier work be laid on the men,
that they may labor in it. Don’t let them
pay any attention to lying words.”
10 The taskmasters of the people went
out with their officers, and they spoke to
the people, saying, “This is what Pharaoh
says: ‘I will not give you straw.
11 Go yourselves, get straw where you
can find it, for nothing of your work shall
be diminished.’ ”
12 So the people were scattered abroad
throughout all the land of Egypt to gather
stubble for straw.
13 The taskmasters were urgent saying,
“Fulfill your work quota daily, as when
there was straw!”
14 The officers of the children of Israel,
whom Pharaoh’s taskmasters had set over
them, were beaten, and were asked, “Why
haven’t you fulfilled your quota both
yesterday and today, in making brick as
before?”
15 Then the officers of the children of
Israel came and cried to Pharaoh, saying,
“Why do you deal this way with your
servants?
16 No straw is given to your servants,
and they tell us, ‘Make brick!’ and behold,
your servants are beaten; but the fault is
in your own people.”
17 But Pharaoh said, “You are idle! You
are idle! Therefore you say, ‘Let’s go and
sacrifice to Yahweh.’
18 Go therefore now, and work; for no
straw shall be given to you; yet you shall
deliver the same number of bricks!”
19 The officers of the children of Israel
saw that they were in trouble when it was
said, “You shall not diminish anything
from your daily quota of bricks!”
20 They met Moses and Aaron, who
stood along the way, as they came out
from Pharaoh.
21 They said to them, “May Yahweh look
at you and judge, because you have made
us a stench to be abhorred in the eyes of
Pharaoh, and in the eyes of his servants,
to put a sword in their hand to kill us!”
22 Moses returned to Yahweh, and said,
“Lord, why have you brought trouble on
this people? Why is it that you have sent
me?
23 For since I came to Pharaoh to speak
in your name, he has brought trouble on
this people. You have not rescued your
people at all!”

6

1 Yahweh said to Moses, “Now you shall
see what I will do to Pharaoh, for by a
strong hand he shall let them go, and by a
strong hand he shall drive them out of his
land.”
2 God spoke to Moses, and said to him, “I
am Yahweh.
3 I appeared to Abraham, to Isaac, and
to Jacob, as God Almighty; but by my
name Yahweh I was not known to them.
4 I have also established my covenant
with them, to give them the land of
Canaan, the land of their travels, in which
they lived as aliens.

5 Moreover I have heard the groaning of
the children of Israel, whom the
Egyptians keep in bondage, and I have
remembered my covenant.
6 Therefore tell the children of Israel, 'I
am Yahweh, and I will bring you out from
under the burdens of the Egyptians, and I
will rid you out of their bondage, and I
will redeem you with an outstretched
arm, and with great judgments.
7 I will take you to myself for a people. I
will be your God; and you shall know that
I am Yahweh your God, who brings you
out from under the burdens of the
Egyptians.
8 I will bring you into the land which I
swore to give to Abraham, to Isaac, and to
Jacob; and I will give it to you for a
heritage: I am Yahweh.' "

9 Moses spoke so to the children of
Israel, but they didn't listen to Moses for
anguish of spirit, and for cruel bondage.

10 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
11 "Go in, speak to Pharaoh king of
Egypt, that he let the children of Israel go
out of his land."
12 Moses spoke before Yahweh, saying,
"Behold, the children of Israel haven't
listened to me. How then shall Pharaoh
listen to me, when I have uncircumcised
lips?"
13 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
and gave them a command to the children
of Israel, and to Pharaoh king of Egypt, to
bring the children of Israel out of the land
of Egypt.

14 These are the heads of their fathers'
houses. The sons of Reuben the firstborn
of Israel: Hanoch, and Pallu, Hezron, and
Carmi; these are the families of Reuben.
15 The sons of Simeon: Jemuel, and
Jamin, and Ohad, and Jachin, and Zohar,
and Shaul the son of a Canaanite woman;
these are the families of Simeon.
16 These are the names of the sons of
Levi according to their generations:
Gershon, and Kohath, and Merari; and the
years of the life of Levi were one hundred
thirty-seven years.
17 The sons of Gershon: Libni and
Shimei, according to their families.
18 The sons of Kohath: Amram, and
Izhar, and Hebron, and Uzziel; and the
years of the life of Kohath were one
hundred thirty-three years.
19 The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi.
These are the families of the Levites
according to their generations.
20 Amram took Jochebed his father's
sister to himself as wife; and she bore him
Aaron and Moses. The years of the life of
Amram were one hundred thirty-seven
years.
21 The sons of Izhar: Korah, and Nepheg,
and Zichri.
22 The sons of Uzziel: Mishael,
Elzaphan, and Sithri.
23 Aaron took Elisheba, the daughter of
Amminadab, the sister of Nahshon, as his
wife; and she bore him Nadab and Abihu,
Eleazar and Ithamar.
24 The sons of Korah: Assir, Elkanah,
and Abiasaph; these are the families of
the Korahites.
25 Eleazar Aaron's son took one of the
daughters of Putiel as his wife; and she
bore him Phinehas. These are the heads
of the fathers' houses of the Levites
according to their families.
26 These are that Aaron and Moses to
whom Yahweh said, "Bring out the
children of Israel from the land of Egypt
according to their armies."
27 These are those who spoke to
Pharaoh king of Egypt, to bring out the
children of Israel from Egypt. These are
that Moses and Aaron.
28 On the day when Yahweh spoke to
Moses in the land of Egypt,
29 Yahweh said to Moses, "I am Yahweh.
Tell Pharaoh king of Egypt all that I tell
you."
30 Moses said before Yahweh, "Behold, I
am of uncircumcised lips, and how shall
Pharaoh listen to me?"

7

1 Yahweh said to Moses, "Behold, I have
made you as God to Pharaoh; and Aaron
your brother shall be your prophet.
2 You shall speak all that I command
you; and Aaron your brother shall speak
to Pharaoh, that he let the children of
Israel go out of his land.

3 I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and
multiply my signs and my wonders in the
land of Egypt.
4 But Pharaoh will not listen to you, so I
will lay my hand on Egypt, and bring out
my armies, my people the children of
Israel, out of the land of Egypt by great
judgments.
5 The Egyptians shall know that I am
Yahweh when I stretch out my hand on
Egypt, and bring the children of Israel out
from among them."
6 Moses and Aaron did so. As Yahweh
commanded them, so they did.
7 Moses was eighty years old, and Aaron
eighty-three years old, when they spoke to
Pharaoh.
8 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
saying,
9 "When Pharaoh speaks to you, saying,
'Perform a miracle!' then you shall tell
Aaron, 'Take your rod, and cast it down
before Pharaoh, and it will become a
serpent.' "
10 Moses and Aaron went in to Pharaoh,
and they did so, as Yahweh had
commanded. Aaron cast down his rod
before Pharaoh and before his servants,
and it became a serpent.
11 Then Pharaoh also called for the wise
men and the sorcerers. They also, the
magicians of Egypt, did the same thing
with their enchantments.
12 For they each cast down their rods,
and they became serpents; but Aaron's
rod swallowed up their rods.
13 Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and
he didn't listen to them, as Yahweh had
spoken.
14 Yahweh said to Moses, "Pharaoh's
heart is stubborn. He refuses to let the
people go.
15 Go to Pharaoh in the morning.
Behold, he is going out to the water. You
shall stand by the river's bank to meet
him. You shall take the rod which was
turned to a serpent in your hand.
16 You shall tell him, 'Yahweh, the God of
the Hebrews, has sent me to you, saying,
"Let my people go, that they may serve me
in the wilderness. Behold, until now you
haven't listened."
17 Yahweh says, "In this you shall know
that I am Yahweh. Behold: I will strike
with the rod that is in my hand on the
waters which are in the river, and they
shall be turned to blood.
18 The fish that are in the river will die
and the river will become foul. The
Egyptians will loathe to drink water from
the river." ' "
19 Yahweh said to Moses, "Tell Aaron,
'Take your rod, and stretch out your hand
over the waters of Egypt, over their rivers,
over their streams, and over their pools,
and over all their ponds of water, that
they may become blood. There will be
blood throughout all the land of Egypt,
both in vessels of wood and in vessels of
stone.' "
20 Moses and Aaron did so, as Yahweh
commanded; and he lifted up the rod, and
struck the waters that were in the river, in
the sight of Pharaoh, and in the sight of
his servants; and all the waters that were
in the river were turned to blood.
21 The fish that were in the river died.
The river became foul. The Egyptians
couldn't drink water from the river. The
blood was throughout all the land of
Egypt.
22 The magicians of Egypt did the same
thing with their enchantments. So
Pharaoh's heart was hardened, and he
didn't listen to them, as Yahweh had
spoken.
23 Pharaoh turned and went into his
house, and he didn't even take this to
heart.
24 All the Egyptians dug around the
river for water to drink; for they couldn't
drink the river water.
25 Seven days were fulfilled, after
Yahweh had struck the river.

8

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, "Go in to
Pharaoh, and tell him, 'This is what
Yahweh says, "Let my people go, that they
may serve me.
2 If you refuse to let them go, behold, I
will plague all your borders with frogs.
3 The river will swarm with frogs, which
will go up and come into your house, and
into your bedroom, and on your bed, and
into the house of your servants, and on

your people, and into your ovens, and into your kneading troughs.
4 The frogs shall come up both on you,
and on your people, and on all your
servants.” ’ ”
5 Yahweh said to Moses, “Tell Aaron,
‘Stretch out your hand with your rod over
the rivers, over the streams, and over the
pools, and cause frogs to come up on the
land of Egypt.’ ”
6 Aaron stretched out his hand over the
waters of Egypt; and the frogs came up,
and covered the land of Egypt.
7 The magicians did the same thing with
their enchantments, and brought up frogs
on the land of Egypt.
8 Then Pharaoh called for Moses and
Aaron, and said, “Entreat Yahweh, that he
take away the frogs from me and from my
people; and I will let the people go, that
they may sacrifice to Yahweh.”
9 Moses said to Pharaoh, “I give you the
honor of setting the time that I should
pray for you, and for your servants, and
for your people, that the frogs be
destroyed from you and your houses, and
remain in the river only.”
10 Pharaoh said, “Tomorrow.”
Moses said, “Let it be according to your
word, that you may know that there is no
one like Yahweh our God.
11 The frogs shall depart from you, and
from your houses, and from your
servants, and from your people. They
shall remain in the river only.”
12 Moses and Aaron went out from
Pharaoh, and Moses cried to Yahweh
concerning the frogs which he had
brought on Pharaoh.
13 Yahweh did according to the word of
Moses, and the frogs died out of the
houses, out of the courts, and out of the
fields.
14 They gathered them together in
heaps, and the land stank.
15 But when Pharaoh saw that there was
a respite, he hardened his heart, and
didn’t listen to them, as Yahweh had
spoken.
16 Yahweh said to Moses, “Tell Aaron,
‘Stretch out your rod, and strike the dust
of the earth, that it may become lice
throughout all the land of Egypt.’ ”
17 They did so; and Aaron stretched out
his hand with his rod, and struck the dust
of the earth, and there were lice on man,
and on animal; all the dust of the earth
became lice throughout all the land of
Egypt.
18 The magicians tried with their
enchantments to produce lice, but they
couldn’t. There were lice on man, and on
animal.
19 Then the magicians said to Pharaoh,
“This is God’s finger;” but Pharaoh’s heart
was hardened, and he didn’t listen to
them, as Yahweh had spoken.
20 Yahweh said to Moses, “Rise up early
in the morning, and stand before
Pharaoh; behold, he comes out to the
water; and tell him, ‘This is what Yahweh
says, “Let my people go, that they may
serve me.
21 Else, if you will not let my people go,
behold, I will send swarms of flies on you,
and on your servants, and on your people,
and into your houses. The houses of the
Egyptians shall be full of swarms of flies,
and also the ground they are on.
22 I will set apart in that day the land of
Goshen, in which my people dwell, that no
swarms of flies shall be there, to the end
you may know that I am Yahweh on the
earth.
23 I will put a division between my
people and your people. This sign shall
happen by tomorrow.” ’ ”
24 Yahweh did so; and there came
grievous swarms of flies into the house of
Pharaoh, and into his servants’ houses. In
all the land of Egypt the land was
corrupted by reason of the swarms of
flies.
25 Pharaoh called for Moses and for
Aaron, and said, “Go, sacrifice to your God
in the land!”
26 Moses said, “It isn’t appropriate to do
so; for we shall sacrifice the abomination
of the Egyptians to Yahweh our God.
Behold, if we sacrifice the abomination of
the Egyptians before their eyes, won’t
they stone us?

27 We will go three days' journey into
the wilderness, and sacrifice to Yahweh
our God, as he shall command us."
28 Pharaoh said, "I will let you go, that
you may sacrifice to Yahweh your God in
the wilderness, only you shall not go very
far away. Pray for me."
29 Moses said, "Behold, I am going out
from you. I will pray to Yahweh that the
swarms of flies may depart from Pharaoh,
from his servants, and from his people,
tomorrow; only don't let Pharaoh deal
deceitfully any more in not letting the
people go to sacrifice to Yahweh."
30 Moses went out from Pharaoh, and
prayed to Yahweh.
31 Yahweh did according to the word of
Moses, and he removed the swarms of
flies from Pharaoh, from his servants, and
from his people. There remained not one.
32 Pharaoh hardened his heart this time
also, and he didn't let the people go.

9

1 Then Yahweh said to Moses, "Go in to
Pharaoh, and tell him, 'This is what
Yahweh, the God of the Hebrews, says:
"Let my people go, that they may serve
me.
2 For if you refuse to let them go, and
hold them still,
3 behold, Yahweh's hand is on your
livestock which are in the field, on the
horses, on the donkeys, on the camels, on
the herds, and on the flocks with a very
grievous pestilence.
4 Yahweh will make a distinction
between the livestock of Israel and the
livestock of Egypt; and nothing shall die of
all that belongs to the children of
Israel." ' "
5 Yahweh appointed a set time, saying,
"Tomorrow Yahweh shall do this thing in
the land."
6 Yahweh did that thing on the next day;
and all the livestock of Egypt died, but of
the livestock of the children of Israel, not
one died.
7 Pharaoh sent, and, behold, there was
not so much as one of the livestock of the
Israelites dead. But the heart of Pharaoh
was stubborn, and he didn't let the people
go.
8 Yahweh said to Moses and to Aaron,
"Take handfuls of ashes of the furnace,
and let Moses sprinkle it toward the sky in
the sight of Pharaoh.
9 It shall become small dust over all the
land of Egypt, and shall be boils and
blisters breaking out on man and on
animal, throughout all the land of Egypt."
10 They took ashes of the furnace, and
stood before Pharaoh; and Moses
sprinkled it up toward the sky; and it
became boils and blisters breaking out on
man and on animal.
11 The magicians couldn't stand before
Moses because of the boils; for the boils
were on the magicians and on all the
Egyptians.
12 Yahweh hardened the heart of
Pharaoh, and he didn't listen to them, as
Yahweh had spoken to Moses.
13 Yahweh said to Moses, "Rise up early
in the morning, and stand before
Pharaoh, and tell him, 'This is what
Yahweh, the God of the Hebrews, says:
"Let my people go, that they may serve
me.
14 For this time I will send all my
plagues against your heart, against your
officials, and against your people; that
you may know that there is no one like me
in all the earth.
15 For now I would have stretched out
my hand, and struck you and your people
with pestilence, and you would have been
cut off from the earth;
16 but indeed for this cause I have made
you stand: to show you my power, and
that my name may be declared
throughout all the earth,
17 because you still exalt yourself
against my people, that you won't let them
go.
18 Behold, tomorrow about this time I
will cause it to rain a very grievous hail,
such as has not been in Egypt since the
day it was founded even until now.
19 Now therefore command that all of
your livestock and all that you have in the
field be brought into shelter. The hail will
come down on every man and animal that
is found in the field, and isn't brought
home, and they will die." ' "

20 Those who feared Yahweh's word
among the servants of Pharaoh made
their servants and their livestock flee into
the houses.
21 Whoever didn't respect Yahweh's
word left his servants and his livestock in
the field.
22 Yahweh said to Moses, "Stretch out
your hand toward the sky, that there may
be hail in all the land of Egypt, on man,
and on animal, and on every herb of the
field, throughout the land of Egypt."
23 Moses stretched out his rod toward
the heavens, and Yahweh sent thunder
and hail; and lightning flashed down to
the earth. Yahweh rained hail on the land
of Egypt.
24 So there was very severe hail, and
lightning mixed with the hail, such as had
not been in all the land of Egypt since it
became a nation.
25 The hail struck throughout all the
land of Egypt all that was in the field, both
man and animal; and the hail struck
every herb of the field, and broke every
tree of the field.
26 Only in the land of Goshen, where the
children of Israel were, there was no hail.
27 Pharaoh sent and called for Moses
and Aaron, and said to them, "I have
sinned this time. Yahweh is righteous, and
I and my people are wicked.
28 Pray to Yahweh; for there has been
enough of mighty thunderings and hail. I
will let you go, and you shall stay no
longer."
29 Moses said to him, "As soon as I have
gone out of the city, I will spread out my
hands to Yahweh. The thunders shall
cease, and there will not be any more hail;
that you may know that the earth is
Yahweh's.
30 But as for you and your servants, I
know that you don't yet fear Yahweh
God."
31 The flax and the barley were struck,
for the barley had ripened and the flax
was blooming.
32 But the wheat and the spelt were not
struck, for they had not grown up.
33 Moses went out of the city from
Pharaoh, and spread out his hands to
Yahweh; and the thunders and hail
ceased, and the rain was not poured on
the earth.
34 When Pharaoh saw that the rain and
the hail and the thunders had ceased, he
sinned yet more, and hardened his heart,
he and his servants.
35 The heart of Pharaoh was hardened,
and he didn't let the children of Israel go,
just as Yahweh had spoken through
Moses.

10

1 Yahweh said to Moses, "Go in to
Pharaoh, for I have hardened his heart
and the heart of his servants, that I may
show these my signs among them;
2 and that you may tell in the hearing of
your son, and of your son's son, what
things I have done to Egypt, and my signs
which I have done among them; that you
may know that I am Yahweh."
3 Moses and Aaron went in to Pharaoh,
and said to him, "This is what Yahweh, the
God of the Hebrews, says: 'How long will
you refuse to humble yourself before me?
Let my people go, that they may serve me.
4 Or else, if you refuse to let my people
go, behold, tomorrow I will bring locusts
into your country,
5 and they shall cover the surface of the
earth, so that one won't be able to see the
earth. They shall eat the residue of that
which has escaped, which remains to you
from the hail, and shall eat every tree
which grows for you out of the field.
6 Your houses shall be filled, and the
houses of all your servants, and the
houses of all the Egyptians, as neither
your fathers nor your fathers' fathers
have seen, since the day that they were on
the earth to this day.' " He turned, and
went out from Pharaoh.
7 Pharaoh's servants said to him, "How
long will this man be a snare to us? Let the
men go, that they may serve Yahweh,
their God. Don't you yet know that Egypt
is destroyed?"
8 Moses and Aaron were brought again
to Pharaoh, and he said to them, "Go,
serve Yahweh your God; but who are
those who will go?"

9 Moses said, “We will go with our
young and with our old. We will go with
our sons and with our daughters, with our
flocks and with our herds; for we must
hold a feast to Yahweh.”
10 He said to them, “Yahweh be with you
if I let you go with your little ones! See,
evil is clearly before your faces.
11 Not so! Go now you who are men, and
serve Yahweh; for that is what you
desire!” Then they were driven out from
Pharaoh’s presence.
12 Yahweh said to Moses, “Stretch out
your hand over the land of Egypt for the
locusts, that they may come up on the
land of Egypt, and eat every herb of the
land, even all that the hail has left.”
13 Moses stretched out his rod over the
land of Egypt, and Yahweh brought an
east wind on the land all that day, and all
night; and when it was morning, the east
wind brought the locusts.
14 The locusts went up over all the land
of Egypt, and rested in all the borders of
Egypt. They were very grievous. Before
them there were no such locusts as they,
nor will there ever be again.
15 For they covered the surface of the
whole earth, so that the land was
darkened, and they ate every herb of the
land, and all the fruit of the trees which
the hail had left. There remained nothing
green, either tree or herb of the field,
through all the land of Egypt.
16 Then Pharaoh called for Moses and
Aaron in haste, and he said, “I have
sinned against Yahweh your God, and
against you.
17 Now therefore please forgive my sin
again, and pray to Yahweh your God, that
he may also take away from me this
death.”
18 Moses went out from Pharaoh, and
prayed to Yahweh.
19 Yahweh sent an exceedingly strong
west wind, which took up the locusts, and
drove them into the Red Sea.† There
remained not one locust in all the borders
of Egypt.
20 But Yahweh hardened Pharaoh’s
heart, and he didn’t let the children of
Israel go.
21 Yahweh said to Moses, “Stretch out
your hand toward the sky, that there may
be darkness over the land of Egypt, even
darkness which may be felt.”
22 Moses stretched out his hand toward
the sky, and there was a thick darkness in
all the land of Egypt for three days.
23 They didn’t see one another, and
nobody rose from his place for three days;
but all the children of Israel had light in
their dwellings.
24 Pharaoh called to Moses, and said,
“Go, serve Yahweh. Only let your flocks
and your herds stay behind. Let your little
ones also go with you.”
25 Moses said, “You must also give into
our hand sacrifices and burnt offerings,
that we may sacrifice to Yahweh our God.
26 Our livestock also shall go with us.
Not a hoof shall be left behind, for of it we
must take to serve Yahweh our God; and
we don’t know with what we must serve
Yahweh, until we come there.”
27 But Yahweh hardened Pharaoh’s
heart, and he wouldn’t let them go.
28 Pharaoh said to him, “Get away from
me! Be careful to see my face no more; for
in the day you see my face you shall die!”
29 Moses said, “You have spoken well. I
will see your face again no more.”

11

1 Yahweh said to Moses, “I will bring yet
one more plague on Pharaoh, and on
Egypt; afterwards he will let you go.
When he lets you go, he will surely thrust
you out altogether.
2 Speak now in the ears of the people,
and let every man ask of his neighbor,
and every woman of her neighbor, jewels
of silver, and jewels of gold.”
3 Yahweh gave the people favor in the
sight of the Egyptians. Moreover, the man
Moses was very great in the land of Egypt,

† **10:19** “Red Sea” is the translation for the Hebrew “Yam Suf”, which could be more literally translated “Sea of Reeds” or “Sea of Cattails”. It refers to the body of water currently known as the Red Sea, or possibly to one of the bodies of water connected to it or near it.

in the sight of Pharaoh's servants, and in the sight of the people.

4 Moses said, "This is what Yahweh says: 'About midnight I will go out into the middle of Egypt,
5 and all the firstborn in the land of Egypt shall die, from the firstborn of Pharaoh who sits on his throne, even to the firstborn of the female servant who is behind the mill, and all the firstborn of livestock.
6 There will be a great cry throughout all the land of Egypt, such as there has not been, nor will be any more.
7 But against any of the children of Israel a dog won't even bark or move its tongue, against man or animal, that you may know that Yahweh makes a distinction between the Egyptians and Israel.
8 All these servants of yours will come down to me, and bow down themselves to me, saying, "Get out, with all the people who follow you;" and after that I will go out.' " He went out from Pharaoh in hot anger.

9 Yahweh said to Moses, "Pharaoh won't listen to you, that my wonders may be multiplied in the land of Egypt."
10 Moses and Aaron did all these wonders before Pharaoh, but Yahweh hardened Pharaoh's heart, and he didn't let the children of Israel go out of his land.

12

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses and Aaron in the land of Egypt, saying,
2 "This month shall be to you the beginning of months. It shall be the first month of the year to you.
3 Speak to all the congregation of Israel, saying, 'On the tenth day of this month, they shall take to them every man a lamb, according to their fathers' houses, a lamb for a household;
4 and if the household is too little for a lamb, then he and his neighbor next to his house shall take one according to the number of the souls. You shall make your count for the lamb according to what everyone can eat.
5 Your lamb shall be without defect, a male a year old. You shall take it from the sheep or from the goats.
6 You shall keep it until the fourteenth day of the same month; and the whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall kill it at evening.
7 They shall take some of the blood, and put it on the two door posts and on the lintel, on the houses in which they shall eat it.
8 They shall eat the meat in that night, roasted with fire, with unleavened bread. They shall eat it with bitter herbs.
9 Don't eat it raw, nor boiled at all with water, but roasted with fire; with its head, its legs and its inner parts.
10 You shall let nothing of it remain until the morning; but that which remains of it until the morning you shall burn with fire.
11 This is how you shall eat it: with your belt on your waist, your sandals on your feet, and your staff in your hand; and you shall eat it in haste: it is Yahweh's Passover.
12 For I will go through the land of Egypt in that night, and will strike all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both man and animal. I will execute judgments against all the gods of Egypt. I am Yahweh.
13 The blood shall be to you for a token on the houses where you are. When I see the blood, I will pass over you, and no plague will be on you to destroy you when I strike the land of Egypt.
14 This day shall be a memorial for you. You shall keep it as a feast to Yahweh. You shall keep it as a feast throughout your generations by an ordinance forever.

15 " 'Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread; even the first day you shall put away yeast out of your houses, for whoever eats leavened bread from the first day until the seventh day, that soul shall be cut off from Israel.
16 In the first day there shall be to you a holy convocation, and in the seventh day a holy convocation; no kind of work shall be done in them, except that which every man must eat, only that may be done by you.

17 You shall observe the feast of
unleavened bread; for in this same day I
have brought your armies out of the land
of Egypt. Therefore you shall observe this
day throughout your generations by an
ordinance forever.
18 In the first month, on the fourteenth
day of the month at evening, you shall eat
unleavened bread, until the twenty first
day of the month at evening.
19 There shall be no yeast found in your
houses for seven days, for whoever eats
that which is leavened, that soul shall be
cut off from the congregation of Israel,
whether he is a foreigner, or one who is
born in the land.
20 You shall eat nothing leavened. In all
your habitations you shall eat unleavened
bread.' "

21 Then Moses called for all the elders of
Israel, and said to them, "Draw out, and
take lambs according to your families,
and kill the Passover.
22 You shall take a bunch of hyssop, and
dip it in the blood that is in the basin, and
strike the lintel and the two door posts
with the blood that is in the basin. None of
you shall go out of the door of his house
until the morning.
23 For Yahweh will pass through to
strike the Egyptians; and when he sees the
blood on the lintel, and on the two door
posts, Yahweh will pass over the door, and
will not allow the destroyer to come in to
your houses to strike you.
24 You shall observe this thing for an
ordinance to you and to your sons forever.
25 It shall happen when you have come
to the land which Yahweh will give you, as
he has promised, that you shall keep this
service.
26 It will happen, when your children
ask you, 'What do you mean by this
service?'
27 that you shall say, 'It is the sacrifice of
Yahweh's Passover, who passed over the
houses of the children of Israel in Egypt,
when he struck the Egyptians, and spared
our houses.' "

The people bowed their heads and
worshiped.

28 The children of Israel went and did
so; as Yahweh had commanded Moses
and Aaron, so they did.

29 At midnight, Yahweh struck all the
firstborn in the land of Egypt, from the
firstborn of Pharaoh who sat on his
throne to the firstborn of the captive who
was in the dungeon, and all the firstborn
of livestock.
30 Pharaoh rose up in the night, he, and
all his servants, and all the Egyptians; and
there was a great cry in Egypt, for there
was not a house where there was not one
dead.
31 He called for Moses and Aaron by
night, and said, "Rise up, get out from
among my people, both you and the
children of Israel; and go, serve Yahweh,
as you have said!
32 Take both your flocks and your herds,
as you have said, and be gone; and bless
me also!"

33 The Egyptians were urgent with the
people, to send them out of the land in
haste, for they said, "We are all dead
men."
34 The people took their dough before it
was leavened, their kneading troughs
being bound up in their clothes on their
shoulders.
35 The children of Israel did according to
the word of Moses; and they asked of the
Egyptians jewels of silver, and jewels of
gold, and clothing.
36 Yahweh gave the people favor in the
sight of the Egyptians, so that they let
them have what they asked. They
plundered the Egyptians.

37 The children of Israel traveled from
Rameses to Succoth, about six hundred
thousand on foot who were men, in
addition to children.
38 A mixed multitude went up also with
them, with flocks, herds, and even very
much livestock.
39 They baked unleavened cakes of the
dough which they brought out of Egypt;
for it wasn't leavened, because they were
thrust out of Egypt, and couldn't wait, and
they had not prepared any food for
themselves.

40 Now the time that the children of Israel lived in Egypt was four hundred thirty years.
41 At the end of four hundred thirty years, to the day, all of Yahweh's armies went out from the land of Egypt.
42 It is a night to be much observed to Yahweh for bringing them out from the land of Egypt. This is that night of Yahweh, to be much observed by all the children of Israel throughout their generations.
43 Yahweh said to Moses and Aaron, "This is the ordinance of the Passover. No foreigner shall eat of it,
44 but every man's servant who is bought for money, when you have circumcised him, then shall he eat of it.
45 A foreigner and a hired servant shall not eat of it.
46 It must be eaten in one house. You shall not carry any of the meat outside of the house. Do not break any of its bones.
47 All the congregation of Israel shall keep it.
48 When a stranger lives as a foreigner with you, and would like to keep the Passover to Yahweh, let all his males be circumcised, and then let him come near and keep it. He shall be as one who is born in the land; but no uncircumcised person shall eat of it.
49 One law shall be to him who is born at home, and to the stranger who lives as a foreigner among you."
50 All the children of Israel did so. As Yahweh commanded Moses and Aaron, so they did.
51 That same day, Yahweh brought the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt by their armies.

13

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Sanctify to me all the firstborn, whatever opens the womb among the children of Israel, both of man and of animal. It is mine."
3 Moses said to the people, "Remember this day, in which you came out of Egypt, out of the house of bondage; for by strength of hand Yahweh brought you out from this place. No leavened bread shall be eaten.
4 Today you go out in the month Abib.
5 It shall be, when Yahweh brings you into the land of the Canaanite, and the Hittite, and the Amorite, and the Hivite, and the Jebusite, which he swore to your fathers to give you, a land flowing with milk and honey, that you shall keep this service in this month.
6 Seven days you shall eat unleavened bread, and in the seventh day shall be a feast to Yahweh.
7 Unleavened bread shall be eaten throughout the seven days; and no leavened bread shall be seen with you. No yeast shall be seen with you, within all your borders.
8 You shall tell your son in that day, saying, 'It is because of that which Yahweh did for me when I came out of Egypt.'
9 It shall be for a sign to you on your hand, and for a memorial between your eyes, that Yahweh's law may be in your mouth; for with a strong hand Yahweh has brought you out of Egypt.
10 You shall therefore keep this ordinance in its season from year to year.
11 "It shall be, when Yahweh brings you into the land of the Canaanite, as he swore to you and to your fathers, and will give it to you,
12 that you shall set apart to Yahweh all that opens the womb, and every firstborn that comes from an animal which you have. The males shall be Yahweh's.
13 Every firstborn of a donkey you shall redeem with a lamb; and if you will not redeem it, then you shall break its neck; and you shall redeem all the firstborn of man among your sons.
14 It shall be, when your son asks you in time to come, saying, 'What is this?' that you shall tell him, 'By strength of hand Yahweh brought us out from Egypt, from the house of bondage.
15 When Pharaoh stubbornly refused to let us go, Yahweh killed all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, both the firstborn of man, and the firstborn of livestock. Therefore I sacrifice to Yahweh all that

opens the womb, being males; but all the
firstborn of my sons I redeem.'
16 It shall be for a sign on your hand,
and for symbols between your eyes; for
by strength of hand Yahweh brought us
out of Egypt."
17 When Pharaoh had let the people go,
God didn't lead them by the way of the
land of the Philistines, although that was
near; for God said, "Lest perhaps the
people change their minds when they see
war, and they return to Egypt";
18 but God led the people around by the
way of the wilderness by the Red Sea; and
the children of Israel went up armed out
of the land of Egypt.
19 Moses took the bones of Joseph with
him, for he had made the children of
Israel swear, saying, "God will surely visit
you, and you shall carry up my bones
away from here with you."
20 They took their journey from Succoth,
and encamped in Etham, in the edge of
the wilderness.
21 Yahweh went before them by day in a
pillar of cloud, to lead them on their way,
and by night in a pillar of fire, to give
them light, that they might go by day and
by night:
22 the pillar of cloud by day, and the
pillar of fire by night, didn't depart from
before the people.

14

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, that
they turn back and encamp before
Pihahiroth, between Migdol and the sea,
before Baal Zephon. You shall encamp
opposite it by the sea.
3 Pharaoh will say of the children of
Israel, 'They are entangled in the land.
The wilderness has shut them in.'
4 I will harden Pharaoh's heart, and he
will follow after them; and I will get honor
over Pharaoh, and over all his armies; and
the Egyptians shall know that I am
Yahweh." They did so.
5 The king of Egypt was told that the
people had fled; and the heart of Pharaoh
and of his servants was changed toward
the people, and they said, "What is this we
have done, that we have let Israel go from
serving us?"
6 He prepared his chariot, and took his
army with him;
7 and he took six hundred chosen
chariots, and all the chariots of Egypt,
with captains over all of them.
8 Yahweh hardened the heart of
Pharaoh king of Egypt, and he pursued
the children of Israel; for the children of
Israel went out with a high hand.†
9 The Egyptians pursued them. All the
horses and chariots of Pharaoh, his
horsemen, and his army overtook them
encamping by the sea, beside Pihahiroth,
before Baal Zephon.
10 When Pharaoh came near, the
children of Israel lifted up their eyes, and
behold, the Egyptians were marching
after them; and they were very afraid.
The children of Israel cried out to Yahweh.
11 They said to Moses, "Because there
were no graves in Egypt, have you taken
us away to die in the wilderness? Why
have you treated us this way, to bring us
out of Egypt?
12 Isn't this the word that we spoke to
you in Egypt, saying, 'Leave us alone, that
we may serve the Egyptians'? For it would
have been better for us to serve the
Egyptians than to die in the wilderness."
13 Moses said to the people, "Don't be
afraid. Stand still, and see the salvation of
Yahweh, which he will work for you
today; for you will never again see the
Egyptians whom you have seen today.
14 Yahweh will fight for you, and you
shall be still."
15 Yahweh said to Moses, "Why do you
cry to me? Speak to the children of Israel,
that they go forward.
16 Lift up your rod, and stretch out your
hand over the sea and divide it. Then the
children of Israel shall go into the middle
of the sea on dry ground.
17 Behold, I myself will harden the
hearts of the Egyptians, and they will go in
after them. I will get myself honor over

† **14:8** or, defiantly.

Pharaoh, and over all his armies, over his chariots, and over his horsemen.
18 The Egyptians shall know that I am Yahweh when I have gotten myself honor over Pharaoh, over his chariots, and over his horsemen."
19 The angel of God, who went before the camp of Israel, moved and went behind them; and the pillar of cloud moved from before them, and stood behind them.
20 It came between the camp of Egypt and the camp of Israel. There was the cloud and the darkness, yet it gave light by night. One didn't come near the other all night.
21 Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and Yahweh caused the sea to go back by a strong east wind all night, and made the sea dry land, and the waters were divided.
22 The children of Israel went into the middle of the sea on the dry ground; and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left.
23 The Egyptians pursued, and went in after them into the middle of the sea: all of Pharaoh's horses, his chariots, and his horsemen.
24 In the morning watch, Yahweh looked out on the Egyptian army through the pillar of fire and of cloud, and confused the Egyptian army.
25 He took off their chariot wheels, and they drove them heavily; so that the Egyptians said, "Let's flee from the face of Israel, for Yahweh fights for them against the Egyptians!"
26 Yahweh said to Moses, "Stretch out your hand over the sea, that the waters may come again on the Egyptians, on their chariots, and on their horsemen."
27 Moses stretched out his hand over the sea, and the sea returned to its strength when the morning appeared; and the Egyptians fled against it. Yahweh overthrew the Egyptians in the middle of the sea.
28 The waters returned, and covered the chariots and the horsemen, even all Pharaoh's army that went in after them into the sea. There remained not so much as one of them.
29 But the children of Israel walked on dry land in the middle of the sea, and the waters were a wall to them on their right hand and on their left.
30 Thus Yahweh saved Israel that day out of the hand of the Egyptians; and Israel saw the Egyptians dead on the seashore.
31 Israel saw the great work which Yahweh did to the Egyptians, and the people feared Yahweh; and they believed in Yahweh and in his servant Moses.

15

1 Then Moses and the children of Israel sang this song to Yahweh, and said,
"I will sing to Yahweh, for he has triumphed gloriously.
He has thrown the horse and his rider into the sea.
2 Yah is my strength and song.
He has become my salvation.
This is my God, and I will praise him;
my father's God, and I will exalt him.
3 Yahweh is a man of war.
Yahweh is his name.
4 He has cast Pharaoh's chariots and his army into the sea.
His chosen captains are sunk in the Red Sea.
5 The deeps cover them.
They went down into the depths like a stone.
6 Your right hand, Yahweh, is glorious in power.
Your right hand, Yahweh, dashes the enemy in pieces.
7 In the greatness of your excellency, you overthrow those who rise up against you.
You send out your wrath. It consumes them as stubble.
8 With the blast of your nostrils, the waters were piled up.
The floods stood upright as a heap.
The deeps were congealed in the heart of the sea.
9 The enemy said, 'I will pursue. I will overtake. I will divide the plunder.
My desire will be satisfied on them.
I will draw my sword. My hand will destroy them.'
10 You blew with your wind.

The sea covered them.
They sank like lead in the mighty waters.
11 Who is like you, Yahweh, among the gods?
Who is like you, glorious in holiness,
fearful in praises, doing wonders?
12 You stretched out your right hand.
The earth swallowed them.
13 "You, in your loving kindness, have led the people that you have redeemed.
You have guided them in your strength to your holy habitation.
14 The peoples have heard.
They tremble.
Pangs have taken hold of the inhabitants of Philistia.
15 Then the chiefs of Edom were dismayed.
Trembling takes hold of the mighty men of Moab.
All the inhabitants of Canaan have melted away.
16 Terror and dread falls on them.
By the greatness of your arm they are as still as a stone,
until your people pass over, Yahweh,
until the people you have purchased pass over.
17 You will bring them in, and plant them in the mountain of your inheritance,
the place, Yahweh, which you have made for yourself to dwell in:
the sanctuary, Lord, which your hands have established.
18 Yahweh will reign forever and ever."

19 For the horses of Pharaoh went in with his chariots and with his horsemen into the sea, and Yahweh brought back the waters of the sea on them; but the children of Israel walked on dry land in the middle of the sea.

20 Miriam the prophetess, the sister of Aaron, took a tambourine in her hand; and all the women went out after her with tambourines and with dances.

21 Miriam answered them,
"Sing to Yahweh, for he has triumphed gloriously.
He has thrown the horse and his rider into the sea."

22 Moses led Israel onward from the Red Sea, and they went out into the wilderness of Shur; and they went three days in the wilderness, and found no water.

23 When they came to Marah, they couldn't drink from the waters of Marah, for they were bitter. Therefore its name was called Marah.†

24 The people murmured against Moses, saying, "What shall we drink?"

25 Then he cried to Yahweh. Yahweh showed him a tree, and he threw it into the waters, and the waters were made sweet. There he made a statute and an ordinance for them, and there he tested them.

26 He said, "If you will diligently listen to Yahweh your God's voice, and will do that which is right in his eyes, and will pay attention to his commandments, and keep all his statutes, I will put none of the diseases on you which I have put on the Egyptians; for I am Yahweh who heals you."

27 They came to Elim, where there were twelve springs of water and seventy palm trees. They encamped there by the waters.

16

1 They took their journey from Elim, and all the congregation of the children of Israel came to the wilderness of Sin, which is between Elim and Sinai, on the fifteenth day of the second month after their departing out of the land of Egypt.

2 The whole congregation of the children of Israel murmured against Moses and against Aaron in the wilderness;

3 and the children of Israel said to them, "We wish that we had died by Yahweh's hand in the land of Egypt, when we sat by the meat pots, when we ate our fill of bread, for you have brought us out into this wilderness to kill this whole assembly with hunger."

4 Then Yahweh said to Moses, "Behold, I will rain bread from the sky for you, and the people shall go out and gather a day's portion every day, that I may test them, whether they will walk in my law or not.

5 It shall come to pass on the sixth day, that they shall prepare that which they

† **15:23** Marah means bitter.

bring in, and it shall be twice as much as they gather daily."

6 Moses and Aaron said to all the children of Israel, "At evening, you shall know that Yahweh has brought you out from the land of Egypt.

7 In the morning, you shall see Yahweh's glory; because he hears your murmurings against Yahweh. Who are we, that you murmur against us?"

8 Moses said, "Now Yahweh will give you meat to eat in the evening, and in the morning bread to satisfy you, because Yahweh hears your murmurings which you murmur against him. And who are we? Your murmurings are not against us, but against Yahweh."

9 Moses said to Aaron, "Tell all the congregation of the children of Israel, 'Come close to Yahweh, for he has heard your murmurings.' "

10 As Aaron spoke to the whole congregation of the children of Israel, they looked toward the wilderness, and behold, Yahweh's glory appeared in the cloud.

11 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,

12 "I have heard the murmurings of the children of Israel. Speak to them, saying, 'At evening you shall eat meat, and in the morning you shall be filled with bread. Then you will know that I am Yahweh your God.' "

13 In the evening, quail came up and covered the camp; and in the morning the dew lay around the camp.

14 When the dew that lay had gone, behold, on the surface of the wilderness was a small round thing, small as the frost on the ground.

15 When the children of Israel saw it, they said to one another, "What is it?" For they didn't know what it was. Moses said to them, "It is the bread which Yahweh has given you to eat.

16 This is the thing which Yahweh has commanded: 'Gather of it everyone according to his eating; an omer† a head, according to the number of your persons, you shall take it, every man for those who are in his tent.' "

17 The children of Israel did so, and some gathered more, some less.

18 When they measured it with an omer, he who gathered much had nothing over, and he who gathered little had no lack. They each gathered according to his eating.

19 Moses said to them, "Let no one leave of it until the morning."

20 Notwithstanding they didn't listen to Moses, but some of them left of it until the morning, so it bred worms and became foul; and Moses was angry with them.

21 They gathered it morning by morning, everyone according to his eating. When the sun grew hot, it melted.

22 On the sixth day, they gathered twice as much bread, two omers for each one; and all the rulers of the congregation came and told Moses.

23 He said to them, "This is that which Yahweh has spoken, 'Tomorrow is a solemn rest, a holy Sabbath to Yahweh. Bake that which you want to bake, and boil that which you want to boil; and all that remains over lay up for yourselves to be kept until the morning.' "

24 They laid it up until the morning, as Moses ordered, and it didn't become foul, and there were no worms in it.

25 Moses said, "Eat that today, for today is a Sabbath to Yahweh. Today you shall not find it in the field.

26 Six days you shall gather it, but on the seventh day is the Sabbath. In it there shall be none."

27 On the seventh day, some of the people went out to gather, and they found none.

28 Yahweh said to Moses, "How long do you refuse to keep my commandments and my laws?

29 Behold, because Yahweh has given you the Sabbath, therefore he gives you on the sixth day the bread of two days. Everyone stay in his place. Let no one go out of his place on the seventh day."

30 So the people rested on the seventh

† **16:16** An omer is about 2.2 liters or about 2.3 quarts ‡ **16:31** "Manna" means "What is it?"

day.
31 The house of Israel called its name
“Manna”,‡ and it was like coriander seed,
white; and its taste was like wafers with
honey.
32 Moses said, “This is the thing which
Yahweh has commanded, ‘Let an
omer-full of it be kept throughout your
generations, that they may see the bread
with which I fed you in the wilderness,
when I brought you out of the land of
Egypt.’ ”
33 Moses said to Aaron, “Take a pot, and
put an omer-full of manna in it, and lay it
up before Yahweh, to be kept throughout
your generations.”
34 As Yahweh commanded Moses, so
Aaron laid it up before the Testimony, to
be kept.
35 The children of Israel ate the manna
forty years, until they came to an
inhabited land. They ate the manna until
they came to the borders of the land of
Canaan.
36 Now an omer is one tenth of an
ephah.§

17

1 All the congregation of the children of
Israel traveled from the wilderness of Sin,
starting according to Yahweh’s
commandment, and encamped in
Rephidim; but there was no water for the
people to drink.
2 Therefore the people quarreled with
Moses, and said, “Give us water to drink.”
Moses said to them, “Why do you
quarrel with me? Why do you test
Yahweh?”
3 The people were thirsty for water
there; so the people murmured against
Moses, and said, “Why have you brought
us up out of Egypt, to kill us, our children,
and our livestock with thirst?”
4 Moses cried to Yahweh, saying, “What
shall I do with these people? They are
almost ready to stone me.”
5 Yahweh said to Moses, “Walk on before
the people, and take the elders of Israel
with you, and take the rod in your hand
with which you struck the Nile, and go.
6 Behold, I will stand before you there
on the rock in Horeb. You shall strike the
rock, and water will come out of it, that
the people may drink.” Moses did so in the
sight of the elders of Israel.
7 He called the name of the place
Massah,† and Meribah,‡ because the
children of Israel quarreled, and because
they tested Yahweh, saying, “Is Yahweh
among us, or not?”
8 Then Amalek came and fought with
Israel in Rephidim.
9 Moses said to Joshua, “Choose men for
us, and go out to fight with Amalek.
Tomorrow I will stand on the top of the
hill with God’s rod in my hand.”
10 So Joshua did as Moses had told him,
and fought with Amalek; and Moses,
Aaron, and Hur went up to the top of the
hill.
11 When Moses held up his hand, Israel
prevailed. When he let down his hand,
Amalek prevailed.
12 But Moses’ hands were heavy; so they
took a stone, and put it under him, and he
sat on it. Aaron and Hur held up his
hands, the one on the one side, and the
other on the other side. His hands were
steady until sunset.
13 Joshua defeated Amalek and his
people with the edge of the sword.
14 Yahweh said to Moses, “Write this for
a memorial in a book, and rehearse it in
the ears of Joshua: that I will utterly blot
out the memory of Amalek from under
the sky.”
15 Moses built an altar, and called its
name “Yahweh our Banner”.§
16 He said, “Yah has sworn: ‘Yahweh will
have war with Amalek from generation to
generation.’ ”

18

1 Now Jethro, the priest of Midian,
Moses’ father-in-law, heard of all that God
had done for Moses and for Israel his
people, how Yahweh had brought Israel
out of Egypt.

§ **16:36** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel † **17:7** Massah means testing. ‡ **17:7** Meribah means quarreling. § **17:15** Hebrew, Yahweh Nissi

2 Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, received
Zipporah, Moses' wife, after he had sent
her away,
3 and her two sons. The name of one son
was Gershom,† for Moses said, "I have
lived as a foreigner in a foreign land".
4 The name of the other was Eliezer,‡ for
he said, "My father's God was my help and
delivered me from Pharaoh's sword."
5 Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, came
with Moses' sons and his wife to Moses
into the wilderness where he was
encamped, at the Mountain of God.
6 He said to Moses, "I, your father-in-law
Jethro, have come to you with your wife,
and her two sons with her."
7 Moses went out to meet his
father-in-law, and bowed and kissed him.
They asked each other of their welfare,
and they came into the tent.
8 Moses told his father-in-law all that
Yahweh had done to Pharaoh and to the
Egyptians for Israel's sake, all the
hardships that had come on them on the
way, and how Yahweh delivered them.
9 Jethro rejoiced for all the goodness
which Yahweh had done to Israel, in that
he had delivered them out of the hand of
the Egyptians.
10 Jethro said, "Blessed be Yahweh, who
has delivered you out of the hand of the
Egyptians, and out of the hand of
Pharaoh; who has delivered the people
from under the hand of the Egyptians.
11 Now I know that Yahweh is greater
than all gods because of the way that they
treated people arrogantly."
12 Jethro, Moses' father-in-law, took a
burnt offering and sacrifices for God.
Aaron came with all the elders of Israel, to
eat bread with Moses' father-in-law
before God.
13 On the next day, Moses sat to judge
the people, and the people stood around
Moses from the morning to the evening.
14 When Moses' father-in-law saw all
that he did to the people, he said, "What is
this thing that you do for the people? Why
do you sit alone, and all the people stand
around you from morning to evening?"
15 Moses said to his father-in-law,
"Because the people come to me to
inquire of God.
16 When they have a matter, they come
to me, and I judge between a man and his
neighbor, and I make them know the
statutes of God, and his laws."
17 Moses' father-in-law said to him, "The
thing that you do is not good.
18 You will surely wear away, both you,
and this people that is with you; for the
thing is too heavy for you. You are not
able to perform it yourself alone.
19 Listen now to my voice. I will give you
counsel, and God be with you. You
represent the people before God, and
bring the causes to God.
20 You shall teach them the statutes and
the laws, and shall show them the way in
which they must walk, and the work that
they must do.
21 Moreover you shall provide out of all
the people able men which fear God: men
of truth, hating unjust gain; and place
such over them, to be rulers of thousands,
rulers of hundreds, rulers of fifties, and
rulers of tens.
22 Let them judge the people at all times.
It shall be that every great matter they
shall bring to you, but every small matter
they shall judge themselves. So shall it be
easier for you, and they shall share the
load with you.
23 If you will do this thing, and God
commands you so, then you will be able to
endure, and all these people also will go to
their place in peace."
24 So Moses listened to the voice of his
father-in-law, and did all that he had said.
25 Moses chose able men out of all Israel,
and made them heads over the people,
rulers of thousands, rulers of hundreds,
rulers of fifties, and rulers of tens.
26 They judged the people at all times.
They brought the hard cases to Moses, but
every small matter they judged
themselves.
27 Moses let his father-in-law depart,
and he went his way into his own land.

† **18:3** "Gershom" sounds like the Hebrew for "an alien there". ‡ **18:4** Eliezer means "God is my helper".

19

1 In the third month after the children
of Israel had gone out of the land of Egypt,
on that same day they came into the
wilderness of Sinai.
2 When they had departed from
Rephidim, and had come to the
wilderness of Sinai, they encamped in the
wilderness; and there Israel encamped
before the mountain.
3 Moses went up to God, and Yahweh
called to him out of the mountain, saying,
"This is what you shall tell the house of
Jacob, and tell the children of Israel:
4 'You have seen what I did to the
Egyptians, and how I bore you on eagles'
wings, and brought you to myself.
5 Now therefore, if you will indeed obey
my voice and keep my covenant, then you
shall be my own possession from among
all peoples; for all the earth is mine;
6 and you shall be to me a kingdom of
priests and a holy nation.' These are the
words which you shall speak to the
children of Israel."
7 Moses came and called for the elders of
the people, and set before them all these
words which Yahweh commanded him.
8 All the people answered together, and
said, "All that Yahweh has spoken we will
do."
Moses reported the words of the people
to Yahweh.
9 Yahweh said to Moses, "Behold, I come
to you in a thick cloud, that the people
may hear when I speak with you, and may
also believe you forever." Moses told the
words of the people to Yahweh.
10 Yahweh said to Moses, "Go to the
people, and sanctify them today and
tomorrow, and let them wash their
garments,
11 and be ready for the third day; for on
the third day Yahweh will come down in
the sight of all the people on Mount Sinai.
12 You shall set bounds to the people all
around, saying, 'Be careful that you don't
go up onto the mountain, or touch its
border. Whoever touches the mountain
shall be surely put to death.
13 No hand shall touch him, but he shall
surely be stoned or shot through; whether
it is animal or man, he shall not live.'
When the trumpet sounds long, they shall
come up to the mountain."

14 Moses went down from the mountain
to the people, and sanctified the people;
and they washed their clothes.
15 He said to the people, "Be ready by
the third day. Don't have sexual relations
with a woman."

16 On the third day, when it was
morning, there were thunders and
lightnings, and a thick cloud on the
mountain, and the sound of an
exceedingly loud trumpet; and all the
people who were in the camp trembled.
17 Moses led the people out of the camp
to meet God; and they stood at the lower
part of the mountain.
18 All of Mount Sinai smoked, because
Yahweh descended on it in fire; and its
smoke ascended like the smoke of a
furnace, and the whole mountain quaked
greatly.
19 When the sound of the trumpet grew
louder and louder, Moses spoke, and God
answered him by a voice.
20 Yahweh came down on Mount Sinai,
to the top of the mountain. Yahweh called
Moses to the top of the mountain, and
Moses went up.

21 Yahweh said to Moses, "Go down,
warn the people, lest they break through
to Yahweh to gaze, and many of them
perish.
22 Let the priests also, who come near to
Yahweh, sanctify themselves, lest Yahweh
break out on them."

23 Moses said to Yahweh, "The people
can't come up to Mount Sinai, for you
warned us, saying, 'Set bounds around the
mountain, and sanctify it.' "

24 Yahweh said to him, "Go down! You
shall bring Aaron up with you, but don't
let the priests and the people break
through to come up to Yahweh, lest he
break out against them."

25 So Moses went down to the people,
and told them.

20

1 God† spoke all these words, saying,
2 "I am Yahweh your God, who brought
you out of the land of Egypt, out of the
house of bondage.
3 "You shall have no other gods before
me.
4 "You shall not make for yourselves an
idol, nor any image of anything that is in
the heavens above, or that is in the earth
beneath, or that is in the water under the
earth:
5 you shall not bow yourself down to
them, nor serve them, for I, Yahweh your
God, am a jealous God, visiting the
iniquity of the fathers on the children, on
the third and on the fourth generation of
those who hate me,
6 and showing loving kindness to
thousands of those who love me and keep
my commandments.
7 "You shall not misuse the name of
Yahweh your God,‡ for Yahweh will not
hold him guiltless who misuses his name.
8 "Remember the Sabbath day, to keep it
holy.
9 You shall labor six days, and do all
your work,
10 but the seventh day is a Sabbath to
Yahweh your God. You shall not do any
work in it, you, nor your son, nor your
daughter, your male servant, nor your
female servant, nor your livestock, nor
your stranger who is within your gates;
11 for in six days Yahweh made heaven
and earth, the sea, and all that is in them,
and rested the seventh day; therefore
Yahweh blessed the Sabbath day, and
made it holy.
12 "Honor your father and your mother,
that your days may be long in the land
which Yahweh your God gives you.
13 "You shall not murder.
14 "You shall not commit adultery.
15 "You shall not steal.
16 "You shall not give false testimony
against your neighbor.
17 "You shall not covet your neighbor's
house. You shall not covet your neighbor's
wife, nor his male servant, nor his female
servant, nor his ox, nor his donkey, nor
anything that is your neighbor's."
18 All the people perceived the
thunderings, the lightnings, the sound of
the trumpet, and the mountain smoking.
When the people saw it, they trembled,
and stayed at a distance.
19 They said to Moses, "Speak with us
yourself, and we will listen; but don't let
God speak with us, lest we die."
20 Moses said to the people, "Don't be
afraid, for God has come to test you, and
that his fear may be before you, that you
won't sin."
21 The people stayed at a distance, and
Moses came near to the thick darkness
where God was.
22 Yahweh said to Moses, "This is what
you shall tell the children of Israel: 'You
yourselves have seen that I have talked
with you from heaven.
23 You shall most certainly not make
gods of silver or gods of gold for
yourselves to be alongside me.
24 You shall make an altar of earth for
me, and shall sacrifice on it your burnt
offerings and your peace offerings, your
sheep and your cattle. In every place
where I record my name I will come to
you and I will bless you.
25 If you make me an altar of stone, you
shall not build it of cut stones; for if you
lift up your tool on it, you have polluted it.
26 You shall not go up by steps to my
altar, that your nakedness may not be
exposed to it.'

21

1 "Now these are the ordinances which
you shall set before them:
2 "If you buy a Hebrew servant, he shall
serve six years, and in the seventh he
shall go out free without paying anything.
3 If he comes in by himself, he shall go
out by himself. If he is married, then his
wife shall go out with him.
4 If his master gives him a wife and she
bears him sons or daughters, the wife and

† **20:1** After "God", the Hebrew has the two letters "Aleph Tav" (the first and last letters of the Hebrew alphabet), not as a word, but as a grammatical marker. ‡ **20:7** or, You shall not take the name of Yahweh your God in vain

her children shall be her master's, and he
shall go out by himself.
5 But if the servant shall plainly say, 'I
love my master, my wife, and my
children. I will not go out free;'
6 then his master shall bring him to God,
and shall bring him to the door or to the
doorpost, and his master shall bore his
ear through with an awl, and he shall
serve him forever.
7 "If a man sells his daughter to be a
female servant, she shall not go out as the
male servants do.
8 If she doesn't please her master, who
has married her to himself, then he shall
let her be redeemed. He shall have no
right to sell her to a foreign people, since
he has dealt deceitfully with her.
9 If he marries her to his son, he shall
deal with her as a daughter.
10 If he takes another wife to himself, he
shall not diminish her food, her clothing,
and her marital rights.
11 If he doesn't do these three things for
her, she may go free without paying any
money.
12 "One who strikes a man so that he
dies shall surely be put to death,
13 but not if it is unintentional, but God
allows it to happen; then I will appoint
you a place where he shall flee.
14 If a man schemes and comes
presumptuously on his neighbor to kill
him, you shall take him from my altar,
that he may die.
15 "Anyone who attacks his father or his
mother shall be surely put to death.
16 "Anyone who kidnaps someone and
sells him, or if he is found in his hand, he
shall surely be put to death.
17 "Anyone who curses his father or his
mother shall surely be put to death.
18 "If men quarrel and one strikes the
other with a stone, or with his fist, and he
doesn't die, but is confined to bed;
19 if he rises again and walks around
with his staff, then he who struck him
shall be cleared; only he shall pay for the
loss of his time, and shall provide for his
healing until he is thoroughly healed.
20 "If a man strikes his servant or his
maid with a rod, and he dies under his
hand, the man shall surely be punished.
21 Notwithstanding, if his servant gets
up after a day or two, he shall not be
punished, for the servant is his property.
22 "If men fight and hurt a pregnant
woman so that she gives birth
prematurely, and yet no harm follows, he
shall be surely fined as much as the
woman's husband demands and the
judges allow.
23 But if any harm follows, then you
must take life for life,
24 eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for
hand, foot for foot,
25 burning for burning, wound for
wound, and bruise for bruise.
26 "If a man strikes his servant's eye, or
his maid's eye, and destroys it, he shall let
him go free for his eye's sake.
27 If he strikes out his male servant's
tooth, or his female servant's tooth, he
shall let the servant go free for his tooth's
sake.
28 "If a bull gores a man or a woman to
death, the bull shall surely be stoned, and
its meat shall not be eaten; but the owner
of the bull shall not be held responsible.
29 But if the bull had a habit of goring in
the past, and this has been testified to its
owner, and he has not kept it in, but it has
killed a man or a woman, the bull shall be
stoned, and its owner shall also be put to
death.
30 If a ransom is imposed on him, then
he shall give for the redemption of his life
whatever is imposed.
31 Whether it has gored a son or has
gored a daughter, according to this
judgment it shall be done to him.
32 If the bull gores a male servant or a
female servant, thirty shekels† of silver
shall be given to their master, and the ox
shall be stoned.
33 "If a man opens a pit, or if a man digs
a pit and doesn't cover it, and a bull or a
donkey falls into it,

† **21:32** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 30 shekels is about 300 grams or about 10.6 ounces.

34 the owner of the pit shall make it
good. He shall give money to its owner,
and the dead animal shall be his.
35 "If one man's bull injures another's,
so that it dies, then they shall sell the live
bull, and divide its price; and they shall
also divide the dead animal.
36 Or if it is known that the bull was in
the habit of goring in the past, and its
owner has not kept it in, he shall surely
pay bull for bull, and the dead animal
shall be his own.

22

1 "If a man steals an ox or a sheep, and
kills it or sells it, he shall pay five oxen for
an ox, and four sheep for a sheep.
2 If the thief is found breaking in, and is
struck so that he dies, there shall be no
guilt of bloodshed for him.
3 If the sun has risen on him, he is guilty
of bloodshed. He shall make restitution. If
he has nothing, then he shall be sold for
his theft.
4 If the stolen property is found in his
hand alive, whether it is ox, donkey, or
sheep, he shall pay double.
5 "If a man causes a field or vineyard to
be eaten by letting his animal loose, and it
grazes in another man's field, he shall
make restitution from the best of his own
field, and from the best of his own
vineyard.
6 "If fire breaks out, and catches in
thorns so that the shocks of grain, or the
standing grain, or the field are consumed;
he who kindled the fire shall surely make
restitution.
7 "If a man delivers to his neighbor
money or stuff to keep, and it is stolen out
of the man's house, if the thief is found, he
shall pay double.
8 If the thief isn't found, then the master
of the house shall come near to God, to
find out whether or not he has put his
hand on his neighbor's goods.
9 For every matter of trespass, whether
it is for ox, for donkey, for sheep, for
clothing, or for any kind of lost thing,
about which one says, 'This is mine,' the
cause of both parties shall come before
God. He whom God condemns shall pay
double to his neighbor.
10 "If a man delivers to his neighbor a
donkey, an ox, a sheep, or any animal to
keep, and it dies or is injured, or driven
away, no man seeing it;
11 the oath of Yahweh shall be between
them both, he has not put his hand on his
neighbor's goods; and its owner shall
accept it, and he shall not make
restitution.
12 But if it is stolen from him, the one
who stole shall make restitution to its
owner.
13 If it is torn in pieces, let him bring it
for evidence. He shall not make good that
which was torn.
14 "If a man borrows anything of his
neighbor's, and it is injured, or dies, its
owner not being with it, he shall surely
make restitution.
15 If its owner is with it, he shall not
make it good. If it is a leased thing, it came
for its lease.
16 "If a man entices a virgin who isn't
pledged to be married, and lies with her,
he shall surely pay a dowry for her to be
his wife.
17 If her father utterly refuses to give
her to him, he shall pay money according
to the dowry of virgins.
18 "You shall not allow a sorceress to
live.
19 "Whoever has sex with an animal
shall surely be put to death.
20 "He who sacrifices to any god, except
to Yahweh only, shall be utterly destroyed.
21 "You shall not wrong an alien or
oppress him, for you were aliens in the
land of Egypt.
22 "You shall not take advantage of any
widow or fatherless child.
23 If you take advantage of them at all,
and they cry at all to me, I will surely hear
their cry;
24 and my wrath will grow hot, and I
will kill you with the sword; and your
wives shall be widows, and your children
fatherless.
25 "If you lend money to any of my
people with you who is poor, you shall not
be to him as a creditor. You shall not
charge him interest.

26 If you take your neighbor's garment
as collateral, you shall restore it to him
before the sun goes down,
27 for that is his only covering, it is his
garment for his skin. What would he
sleep in? It will happen, when he cries to
me, that I will hear, for I am gracious.
28 "You shall not blaspheme God, nor
curse a ruler of your people.
29 "You shall not delay to offer from
your harvest and from the outflow of your
presses.
"You shall give the firstborn of your
sons to me.
30 You shall do likewise with your cattle
and with your sheep. It shall be with its
mother seven days, then on the eighth day
you shall give it to me.
31 "You shall be holy men to me,
therefore you shall not eat any meat that
is torn by animals in the field. You shall
cast it to the dogs.

23

1 "You shall not spread a false report.
Don't join your hand with the wicked to
be a malicious witness.
2 "You shall not follow a crowd to do
evil. You shall not testify in court to side
with a multitude to pervert justice.
3 You shall not favor a poor man in his
cause.
4 "If you meet your enemy's ox or his
donkey going astray, you shall surely
bring it back to him again.
5 If you see the donkey of him who hates
you fallen down under his burden, don't
leave him. You shall surely help him with
it.
6 "You shall not deny justice to your
poor people in their lawsuits.
7 "Keep far from a false charge, and
don't kill the innocent and righteous; for I
will not justify the wicked.
8 "You shall take no bribe, for a bribe
blinds those who have sight and perverts
the words of the righteous.
9 "You shall not oppress an alien, for you
know the heart of an alien, since you were
aliens in the land of Egypt.
10 "For six years you shall sow your
land, and shall gather in its increase,
11 but the seventh year you shall let it
rest and lie fallow, that the poor of your
people may eat; and what they leave the
animal of the field shall eat. In the same
way, you shall deal with your vineyard
and with your olive grove.
12 "Six days you shall do your work, and
on the seventh day you shall rest, that
your ox and your donkey may have rest,
and the son of your servant, and the alien
may be refreshed.
13 "Be careful to do all things that I have
said to you; and don't invoke the name of
other gods or even let them be heard out
of your mouth.
14 "You shall observe a feast to me three
times a year.
15 You shall observe the feast of
unleavened bread. Seven days you shall
eat unleavened bread, as I commanded
you, at the time appointed in the month
Abib (for in it you came out of Egypt), and
no one shall appear before me empty.
16 And the feast of harvest, the first
fruits of your labors, which you sow in the
field; and the feast of ingathering, at the
end of the year, when you gather in your
labors out of the field.
17 Three times in the year all your males
shall appear before the Lord Yahweh.
18 "You shall not offer the blood of my
sacrifice with leavened bread. The fat of
my feast shall not remain all night until
the morning.
19 You shall bring the first of the first
fruits of your ground into the house of
Yahweh your God.
"You shall not boil a young goat in its
mother's milk.
20 "Behold, I send an angel before you,
to keep you by the way, and to bring you
into the place which I have prepared.
21 Pay attention to him, and listen to his
voice. Don't provoke him, for he will not
pardon your disobedience, for my name is
in him.
22 But if you indeed listen to his voice,
and do all that I speak, then I will be an
enemy to your enemies, and an adversary
to your adversaries.

23 For my angel shall go before you, and
bring you in to the Amorite, the Hittite,
the Perizzite, the Canaanite, the Hivite,
and the Jebusite; and I will cut them off.
24 You shall not bow down to their gods,
nor serve them, nor follow their practices,
but you shall utterly overthrow them and
demolish their pillars.
25 You shall serve Yahweh your God,
and he will bless your bread and your
water, and I will take sickness away from
among you.
26 No one will miscarry or be barren in
your land. I will fulfill the number of your
days.
27 I will send my terror before you, and
will confuse all the people to whom you
come, and I will make all your enemies
turn their backs to you.
28 I will send the hornet before you,
which will drive out the Hivite, the
Canaanite, and the Hittite, from before
you.
29 I will not drive them out from before
you in one year, lest the land become
desolate, and the animals of the field
multiply against you.
30 Little by little I will drive them out
from before you, until you have increased
and inherit the land.
31 I will set your border from the Red
Sea even to the sea of the Philistines, and
from the wilderness to the River; for I will
deliver the inhabitants of the land into
your hand, and you shall drive them out
before you.
32 You shall make no covenant with
them, nor with their gods.
33 They shall not dwell in your land, lest
they make you sin against me, for if you
serve their gods, it will surely be a snare
to you."

24

1 He said to Moses, "Come up to Yahweh,
you, and Aaron, Nadab, and Abihu, and
seventy of the elders of Israel; and
worship from a distance.
2 Moses alone shall come near to
Yahweh, but they shall not come near.
The people shall not go up with him."
3 Moses came and told the people all
Yahweh's words, and all the ordinances;
and all the people answered with one
voice, and said, "All the words which
Yahweh has spoken will we do."
4 Moses wrote all Yahweh's words, then
rose up early in the morning and built an
altar at the base of the mountain, with
twelve pillars for the twelve tribes of
Israel.
5 He sent young men of the children of
Israel, who offered burnt offerings and
sacrificed peace offerings of cattle to
Yahweh.
6 Moses took half of the blood and put it
in basins, and half of the blood he
sprinkled on the altar.
7 He took the book of the covenant and
read it in the hearing of the people, and
they said, "We will do all that Yahweh has
said, and be obedient."
8 Moses took the blood, and sprinkled it
on the people, and said, "Look, this is the
blood of the covenant, which Yahweh has
made with you concerning all these
words."
9 Then Moses, Aaron, Nadab, Abihu, and
seventy of the elders of Israel went up.
10 They saw the God of Israel. Under his
feet was like a paved work of sapphire†
stone, like the skies for clearness.
11 He didn't lay his hand on the nobles of
the children of Israel. They saw God, and
ate and drank.
12 Yahweh said to Moses, "Come up to
me on the mountain, and stay here, and I
will give you the stone tablets with the
law and the commands that I have
written, that you may teach them."
13 Moses rose up with Joshua, his
servant, and Moses went up onto God's
Mountain.
14 He said to the elders, "Wait here for
us, until we come again to you. Behold,
Aaron and Hur are with you. Whoever is
involved in a dispute can go to them."
15 Moses went up on the mountain, and
the cloud covered the mountain.
16 Yahweh's glory settled on Mount
Sinai, and the cloud covered it six days.

† **24:10** or, lapis lazuli

The seventh day he called to Moses out of the middle of the cloud.
17 The appearance of Yahweh's glory was like devouring fire on the top of the mountain in the eyes of the children of Israel.
18 Moses entered into the middle of the cloud, and went up on the mountain; and Moses was on the mountain forty days and forty nights.

25

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, that they take an offering for me. From everyone whose heart makes him willing you shall take my offering.
3 This is the offering which you shall take from them: gold, silver, bronze,
4 blue, purple, scarlet, fine linen, goats' hair,
5 rams' skins dyed red, sea cow hides,† acacia wood,
6 oil for the light, spices for the anointing oil and for the sweet incense,
7 onyx stones, and stones to be set for the ephod and for the breastplate.
8 Let them make me a sanctuary, that I may dwell among them.
9 According to all that I show you, the pattern of the tabernacle, and the pattern of all of its furniture, even so you shall make it.
10 "They shall make an ark of acacia wood. Its length shall be two and a half cubits,‡ its width a cubit and a half, and a cubit and a half its height.
11 You shall overlay it with pure gold. You shall overlay it inside and outside, and you shall make a gold molding around it.
12 You shall cast four rings of gold for it, and put them in its four feet. Two rings shall be on the one side of it, and two rings on the other side of it.
13 You shall make poles of acacia wood, and overlay them with gold.
14 You shall put the poles into the rings on the sides of the ark to carry the ark.
15 The poles shall be in the rings of the ark. They shall not be taken from it.
16 You shall put the covenant which I shall give you into the ark.
17 You shall make a mercy seat of pure gold. Two and a half cubits shall be its length, and a cubit and a half its width.
18 You shall make two cherubim of hammered gold. You shall make them at the two ends of the mercy seat.
19 Make one cherub at the one end, and one cherub at the other end. You shall make the cherubim on its two ends of one piece with the mercy seat.
20 The cherubim shall spread out their wings upward, covering the mercy seat with their wings, with their faces toward one another. The faces of the cherubim shall be toward the mercy seat.
21 You shall put the mercy seat on top of the ark, and in the ark you shall put the covenant that I will give you.
22 There I will meet with you, and I will tell you from above the mercy seat, from between the two cherubim which are on the ark of the covenant, all that I command you for the children of Israel.
23 "You shall make a table of acacia wood. Its length shall be two cubits, and its width a cubit, and its height one and a half cubits.
24 You shall overlay it with pure gold, and make a gold molding around it.
25 You shall make a rim of a hand width around it. You shall make a golden molding on its rim around it.
26 You shall make four rings of gold for it, and put the rings in the four corners that are on its four feet.
27 The rings shall be close to the rim, for places for the poles to carry the table.
28 You shall make the poles of acacia wood, and overlay them with gold, that the table may be carried with them.
29 You shall make its dishes, its spoons, its ladles, and its bowls with which to pour out offerings. You shall make them of pure gold.
30 You shall set bread of the presence on the table before me always.

† **25:5** or, fine leather ‡ **25:10** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

31 “You shall make a lamp stand of pure
gold. The lamp stand shall be made of
hammered work. Its base, its shaft, its
cups, its buds, and its flowers shall be of
one piece with it.
32 There shall be six branches going out
of its sides: three branches of the lamp
stand out of its one side, and three
branches of the lamp stand out of its other
side;
33 three cups made like almond
blossoms in one branch, a bud and a
flower; and three cups made like almond
blossoms in the other branch, a bud and a
flower, so for the six branches going out of
the lamp stand;
34 and in the lamp stand four cups made
like almond blossoms, its buds and its
flowers;
35 and a bud under two branches of one
piece with it, and a bud under two
branches of one piece with it, and a bud
under two branches of one piece with it,
for the six branches going out of the lamp
stand.
36 Their buds and their branches shall
be of one piece with it, all of it one beaten
work of pure gold.
37 You shall make its lamps seven, and
they shall light its lamps to give light to
the space in front of it.
38 Its snuffers and its snuff dishes shall
be of pure gold.
39 It shall be made of a talent§ of pure
gold, with all these accessories.
40 See that you make them after their
pattern, which has been shown to you on
the mountain.

26

1 “Moreover you shall make the
tabernacle with ten curtains of fine
twined linen, and blue, and purple, and
scarlet, with cherubim. You shall make
them with the work of a skillful workman.
2 The length of each curtain shall be
twenty-eight cubits,† and the width of
each curtain four cubits: all the curtains
shall have one measure.
3 Five curtains shall be coupled together
to one another, and the other five curtains
shall be coupled to one another.
4 You shall make loops of blue on the
edge of the one curtain from the edge in
the coupling, and you shall do likewise on
the edge of the curtain that is outermost
in the second coupling.
5 You shall make fifty loops in the one
curtain, and you shall make fifty loops in
the edge of the curtain that is in the
second coupling. The loops shall be
opposite one another.
6 You shall make fifty clasps of gold, and
couple the curtains to one another with
the clasps. The tabernacle shall be a unit.
7 “You shall make curtains of goats’ hair
for a covering over the tabernacle. You
shall make eleven curtains.
8 The length of each curtain shall be
thirty cubits, and the width of each
curtain four cubits: the eleven curtains
shall have one measure.
9 You shall couple five curtains by
themselves, and six curtains by
themselves, and shall double over the
sixth curtain in the forefront of the tent.
10 You shall make fifty loops on the edge
of the one curtain that is outermost in the
coupling, and fifty loops on the edge of the
curtain which is outermost in the second
coupling.
11 You shall make fifty clasps of bronze,
and put the clasps into the loops, and
couple the tent together, that it may be
one.
12 The overhanging part that remains of
the curtains of the tent—the half curtain
that remains—shall hang over the back of
the tabernacle.
13 The cubit on the one side and the
cubit on the other side, of that which
remains in the length of the curtains of
the tent, shall hang over the sides of the
tabernacle on this side and on that side, to
cover it.
14 You shall make a covering for the tent
of rams’ skins dyed red, and a covering of
sea cow hides above.
15 “You shall make the boards for the

§ **25:39** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces † **26:2** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

tabernacle of acacia wood, standing upright.
16 Ten cubits shall be the length of a board, and one and a half cubits the width of each board.
17 There shall be two tenons in each board, joined to one another: thus you shall make for all the boards of the tabernacle.
18 You shall make twenty boards for the tabernacle, for the south side southward.
19 You shall make forty sockets of silver under the twenty boards; two sockets under one board for its two tenons, and two sockets under another board for its two tenons.
20 For the second side of the tabernacle, on the north side, twenty boards,
21 and their forty sockets of silver; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board.
22 For the far side of the tabernacle westward you shall make six boards.
23 You shall make two boards for the corners of the tabernacle in the far side.
24 They shall be double beneath, and in the same way they shall be whole to its top to one ring: thus shall it be for them both; they shall be for the two corners.
25 There shall be eight boards, and their sockets of silver, sixteen sockets; two sockets under one board, and two sockets under another board.
26 "You shall make bars of acacia wood: five for the boards of the one side of the tabernacle,
27 and five bars for the boards of the other side of the tabernacle, and five bars for the boards of the side of the tabernacle, for the far side westward.
28 The middle bar in the middle of the boards shall pass through from end to end.
29 You shall overlay the boards with gold, and make their rings of gold for places for the bars. You shall overlay the bars with gold.
30 You shall set up the tabernacle according to the way that it was shown to you on the mountain.
31 "You shall make a veil of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, with cherubim. It shall be the work of a skillful workman.
32 You shall hang it on four pillars of acacia overlaid with gold; their hooks shall be of gold, on four sockets of silver.
33 You shall hang up the veil under the clasps, and shall bring the ark of the covenant in there within the veil. The veil shall separate the holy place from the most holy for you.
34 You shall put the mercy seat on the ark of the covenant in the most holy place.
35 You shall set the table outside the veil, and the lamp stand opposite the table on the side of the tabernacle toward the south. You shall put the table on the north side.
36 "You shall make a screen for the door of the Tent, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, the work of the embroiderer.
37 You shall make for the screen five pillars of acacia, and overlay them with gold. Their hooks shall be of gold. You shall cast five sockets of bronze for them.

27

1 "You shall make the altar of acacia wood, five cubits† long, and five cubits wide. The altar shall be square. Its height shall be three cubits.‡
2 You shall make its horns on its four corners. Its horns shall be of one piece with it. You shall overlay it with bronze.
3 You shall make its pots to take away its ashes; and its shovels, its basins, its meat hooks, and its fire pans. You shall make all its vessels of bronze.
4 You shall make a grating for it of network of bronze. On the net you shall make four bronze rings in its four corners.
5 You shall put it under the ledge around the altar beneath, that the net may reach halfway up the altar.
6 You shall make poles for the altar, poles of acacia wood, and overlay them with bronze.

† **27:1** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. ‡ **27:1** The altar was to be about 2.3×2.3×1.4 meters or about 7½×7½×4½ feet.

7 Its poles shall be put into the rings, and
the poles shall be on the two sides of the
altar when carrying it.
8 You shall make it hollow with planks.
They shall make it as it has been shown
you on the mountain.

9 "You shall make the court of the
tabernacle: for the south side southward
there shall be hangings for the court of
fine twined linen one hundred cubits long
for one side.
10 Its pillars shall be twenty, and their
sockets twenty, of bronze. The hooks of
the pillars and their fillets shall be of
silver.
11 Likewise for the length of the north
side, there shall be hangings one hundred
cubits long, and its pillars twenty, and
their sockets twenty, of bronze; the hooks
of the pillars, and their fillets, of silver.
12 For the width of the court on the west
side shall be hangings of fifty cubits; their
pillars ten, and their sockets ten.
13 The width of the court on the east side
eastward shall be fifty cubits.
14 The hangings for the one side of the
gate shall be fifteen cubits; their pillars
three, and their sockets three.
15 For the other side shall be hangings of
fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their
sockets three.
16 For the gate of the court shall be a
screen of twenty cubits, of blue, and
purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen,
the work of the embroiderer; their pillars
four, and their sockets four.
17 All the pillars of the court around
shall be filleted with silver; their hooks of
silver, and their sockets of bronze.
18 The length of the court shall be one
hundred cubits, and the width fifty
throughout, and the height five cubits, of
fine twined linen, and their sockets of
bronze.
19 All the instruments of the tabernacle
in all its service, and all its pins, and all
the pins of the court, shall be of bronze.

20 "You shall command the children of
Israel, that they bring to you pure olive oil
beaten for the light, to cause a lamp to
burn continually.

21 In the Tent of Meeting, outside the
veil which is before the covenant, Aaron
and his sons shall keep it in order from
evening to morning before Yahweh: it
shall be a statute forever throughout their
generations on the behalf of the children
of Israel.

28

1 "Bring Aaron your brother, and his
sons with him, near to you from among
the children of Israel, that he may
minister to me in the priest's office:
Aaron, with Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and
Ithamar, Aaron's sons.
2 You shall make holy garments for
Aaron your brother, for glory and for
beauty.
3 You shall speak to all who are
wise-hearted, whom I have filled with the
spirit of wisdom, that they make Aaron's
garments to sanctify him, that he may
minister to me in the priest's office.
4 These are the garments which they
shall make: a breastplate, an ephod, a
robe, a fitted tunic, a turban, and a sash.
They shall make holy garments for Aaron
your brother and his sons, that he may
minister to me in the priest's office.
5 They shall use the gold, and the blue,
and the purple, and the scarlet, and the
fine linen.
6 "They shall make the ephod of gold,
blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined
linen, the work of the skillful workman.
7 It shall have two shoulder straps
joined to the two ends of it, that it may be
joined together.
8 The skillfully woven band, which is on
it, shall be like its work and of the same
piece; of gold, blue, purple, scarlet, and
fine twined linen.
9 You shall take two onyx stones, and
engrave on them the names of the
children of Israel.
10 Six of their names on the one stone,
and the names of the six that remain on
the other stone, in the order of their birth.
11 With the work of an engraver in
stone, like the engravings of a signet, you
shall engrave the two stones, according to
the names of the children of Israel. You

shall make them to be enclosed in settings of gold.
12 You shall put the two stones on the shoulder straps of the ephod, to be stones of memorial for the children of Israel. Aaron shall bear their names before Yahweh on his two shoulders for a memorial.
13 You shall make settings of gold,
14 and two chains of pure gold; you shall make them like cords of braided work. You shall put the braided chains on the settings.
15 "You shall make a breastplate of judgment, the work of the skillful workman; like the work of the ephod you shall make it; of gold, of blue, and purple, and scarlet, and fine twined linen, you shall make it.
16 It shall be square and folded double; a span† shall be its length, and a span its width.
17 You shall set in it settings of stones, four rows of stones: a row of ruby, topaz, and beryl shall be the first row;
18 and the second row a turquoise, a sapphire,‡ and an emerald;
19 and the third row a jacinth, an agate, and an amethyst;
20 and the fourth row a chrysolite, an onyx, and a jasper. They shall be enclosed in gold in their settings.
21 The stones shall be according to the names of the children of Israel, twelve, according to their names; like the engravings of a signet, everyone according to his name, they shall be for the twelve tribes.
22 You shall make on the breastplate chains like cords, of braided work of pure gold.
23 You shall make on the breastplate two rings of gold, and shall put the two rings on the two ends of the breastplate.
24 You shall put the two braided chains of gold in the two rings at the ends of the breastplate.
25 The other two ends of the two braided chains you shall put on the two settings, and put them on the shoulder straps of the ephod in its forepart.
26 You shall make two rings of gold, and you shall put them on the two ends of the breastplate, on its edge, which is toward the side of the ephod inward.
27 You shall make two rings of gold, and shall put them on the two shoulder straps of the ephod underneath, in its forepart, close by its coupling, above the skillfully woven band of the ephod.
28 They shall bind the breastplate by its rings to the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, that it may be on the skillfully woven band of the ephod, and that the breastplate may not swing out from the ephod.
29 Aaron shall bear the names of the children of Israel in the breastplate of judgment on his heart, when he goes in to the holy place, for a memorial before Yahweh continually.
30 You shall put in the breastplate of judgment the Urim and the Thummim; and they shall be on Aaron's heart, when he goes in before Yahweh. Aaron shall bear the judgment of the children of Israel on his heart before Yahweh continually.
31 "You shall make the robe of the ephod all of blue.
32 It shall have a hole for the head in the middle of it. It shall have a binding of woven work around its hole, as it were the hole of a coat of mail, that it not be torn.
33 On its hem you shall make pomegranates of blue, and of purple, and of scarlet, all around its hem; with bells of gold between and around them:
34 a golden bell and a pomegranate, a golden bell and a pomegranate, around the hem of the robe.
35 It shall be on Aaron to minister: and its sound shall be heard when he goes in to the holy place before Yahweh, and when he comes out, that he not die.
36 "You shall make a plate of pure gold, and engrave on it, like the engravings of a signet, 'HOLY TO YAHWEH.'

† **28:16** A span is the length from the tip of a man's thumb to the tip of his little finger when his hand is stretched out (about half a cubit, or 9 inches, or 22.8 cm.) ‡ **28:18** or, lapis lazuli

37 You shall put it on a lace of blue, and it
shall be on the sash. It shall be on the
front of the sash.
38 It shall be on Aaron's forehead, and
Aaron shall bear the iniquity of the holy
things, which the children of Israel shall
make holy in all their holy gifts; and it
shall be always on his forehead, that they
may be accepted before Yahweh.
39 You shall weave the tunic with fine
linen. You shall make a turban of fine
linen. You shall make a sash, the work of
the embroiderer.
40 "You shall make tunics for Aaron's
sons. You shall make sashes for them. You
shall make headbands for them, for glory
and for beauty.
41 You shall put them on Aaron your
brother, and on his sons with him, and
shall anoint them, and consecrate them,
and sanctify them, that they may minister
to me in the priest's office.
42 You shall make them linen pants to
cover their naked flesh. They shall reach
from the waist even to the thighs.
43 They shall be on Aaron and on his
sons, when they go in to the Tent of
Meeting, or when they come near to the
altar to minister in the holy place, that
they don't bear iniquity, and die. This
shall be a statute forever to him and to his
offspring after him.

29

1 "This is the thing that you shall do to
them to make them holy, to minister to me
in the priest's office: take one young bull
and two rams without defect,
2 unleavened bread, unleavened cakes
mixed with oil, and unleavened wafers
anointed with oil. You shall make them of
fine wheat flour.
3 You shall put them into one basket,
and bring them in the basket, with the
bull and the two rams.
4 You shall bring Aaron and his sons to
the door of the Tent of Meeting, and shall
wash them with water.
5 You shall take the garments, and put
on Aaron the tunic, the robe of the ephod,
the ephod, and the breastplate, and clothe
him with the skillfully woven band of the
ephod.
6 You shall set the turban on his head,
and put the holy crown on the turban.
7 Then you shall take the anointing oil,
and pour it on his head, and anoint him.
8 You shall bring his sons, and put tunics
on them.
9 You shall clothe them with belts,
Aaron and his sons, and bind headbands
on them. They shall have the priesthood
by a perpetual statute. You shall
consecrate Aaron and his sons.
10 "You shall bring the bull before the
Tent of Meeting; and Aaron and his sons
shall lay their hands on the head of the
bull.
11 You shall kill the bull before Yahweh
at the door of the Tent of Meeting.
12 You shall take of the blood of the bull,
and put it on the horns of the altar with
your finger; and you shall pour out all the
blood at the base of the altar.
13 You shall take all the fat that covers
the innards, the cover of the liver, the two
kidneys, and the fat that is on them, and
burn them on the altar.
14 But the meat of the bull, and its skin,
and its dung, you shall burn with fire
outside of the camp. It is a sin offering.
15 "You shall also take the one ram, and
Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands
on the head of the ram.
16 You shall kill the ram, and you shall
take its blood, and sprinkle it around on
the altar.
17 You shall cut the ram into its pieces,
and wash its innards, and its legs, and put
them with its pieces, and with its head.
18 You shall burn the whole ram on the
altar: it is a burnt offering to Yahweh; it is
a pleasant aroma, an offering made by
fire to Yahweh.
19 "You shall take the other ram, and
Aaron and his sons shall lay their hands
on the head of the ram.
20 Then you shall kill the ram, and take
some of its blood, and put it on the tip of
the right ear of Aaron, and on the tip of
the right ear of his sons, and on the thumb
of their right hand, and on the big toe of
their right foot; and sprinkle the blood
around on the altar.
21 You shall take of the blood that is on
the altar, and of the anointing oil, and

sprinkle it on Aaron, and on his garments, and on his sons, and on the garments of his sons with him: and he shall be made holy, and his garments, and his sons, and his sons' garments with him.

22 Also you shall take some of the ram's fat, the fat tail, the fat that covers the innards, the cover of the liver, the two kidneys, the fat that is on them, and the right thigh (for it is a ram of consecration),

23 and one loaf of bread, one cake of oiled bread, and one wafer out of the basket of unleavened bread that is before Yahweh.

24 You shall put all of this in Aaron's hands, and in his sons' hands, and shall wave them for a wave offering before Yahweh.

25 You shall take them from their hands, and burn them on the altar on the burnt offering, for a pleasant aroma before Yahweh: it is an offering made by fire to Yahweh.

26 "You shall take the breast of Aaron's ram of consecration, and wave it for a wave offering before Yahweh. It shall be your portion.

27 You shall sanctify the breast of the wave offering and the thigh of the wave offering, which is waved, and which is raised up, of the ram of consecration, even of that which is for Aaron, and of that which is for his sons.

28 It shall be for Aaron and his sons as their portion forever from the children of Israel; for it is a wave offering. It shall be a wave offering from the children of Israel of the sacrifices of their peace offerings, even their wave offering to Yahweh.

29 "The holy garments of Aaron shall be for his sons after him, to be anointed in them, and to be consecrated in them.

30 Seven days shall the son who is priest in his place put them on, when he comes into the Tent of Meeting to minister in the holy place.

31 "You shall take the ram of consecration and boil its meat in a holy place.

32 Aaron and his sons shall eat the meat of the ram, and the bread that is in the basket, at the door of the Tent of Meeting.

33 They shall eat those things with which atonement was made, to consecrate and sanctify them; but a stranger shall not eat of it, because they are holy.

34 If anything of the meat of the consecration, or of the bread, remains to the morning, then you shall burn the remainder with fire. It shall not be eaten, because it is holy.

35 "You shall do so to Aaron and to his sons, according to all that I have commanded you. You shall consecrate them seven days.

36 Every day you shall offer the bull of sin offering for atonement. You shall cleanse the altar when you make atonement for it. You shall anoint it, to sanctify it.

37 Seven days you shall make atonement for the altar, and sanctify it; and the altar shall be most holy. Whatever touches the altar shall be holy.

38 "Now this is that which you shall offer on the altar: two lambs a year old day by day continually.

39 The one lamb you shall offer in the morning; and the other lamb you shall offer at evening;

40 and with the one lamb a tenth part of an ephah† of fine flour mixed with the fourth part of a hin‡ of beaten oil, and the fourth part of a hin of wine for a drink offering.

41 The other lamb you shall offer at evening, and shall do to it according to the meal offering of the morning and according to its drink offering, for a pleasant aroma, an offering made by fire to Yahweh.

42 It shall be a continual burnt offering throughout your generations at the door of the Tent of Meeting before Yahweh, where I will meet with you, to speak there to you.

43 There I will meet with the children of Israel; and the place shall be sanctified by

† **29:40** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

‡ **29:40** A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons, so a fourth of a hin is about 1.6 liters.

my glory.
44 I will sanctify the Tent of Meeting and
the altar. I will also sanctify Aaron and his
sons to minister to me in the priest's office.
45 I will dwell among the children of
Israel, and will be their God.
46 They shall know that I am Yahweh
their God, who brought them out of the
land of Egypt, that I might dwell among
them: I am Yahweh their God.

30

1 "You shall make an altar to burn
incense on. You shall make it of acacia
wood.
2 Its length shall be a cubit,† and its
width a cubit. It shall be square, and its
height shall be two cubits. Its horns shall
be of one piece with it.
3 You shall overlay it with pure gold, its
top, its sides around it, and its horns; and
you shall make a gold molding around it.
4 You shall make two golden rings for it
under its molding; on its two ribs, on its
two sides you shall make them; and they
shall be for places for poles with which to
bear it.
5 You shall make the poles of acacia
wood, and overlay them with gold.
6 You shall put it before the veil that is
by the ark of the covenant, before the
mercy seat that is over the covenant,
where I will meet with you.
7 Aaron shall burn incense of sweet
spices on it every morning. When he
tends the lamps, he shall burn it.
8 When Aaron lights the lamps at
evening, he shall burn it, a perpetual
incense before Yahweh throughout your
generations.
9 You shall offer no strange incense on
it, nor burnt offering, nor meal offering;
and you shall pour no drink offering on it.
10 Aaron shall make atonement on its
horns once in the year; with the blood of
the sin offering of atonement once in the
year he shall make atonement for it
throughout your generations. It is most
holy to Yahweh."
11 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
12 "When you take a census of the
children of Israel, according to those who
are counted among them, then each man
shall give a ransom for his soul to Yahweh
when you count them, that there be no
plague among them when you count
them.
13 They shall give this, everyone who
passes over to those who are counted, half
a shekel according to the shekel‡ of the
sanctuary (the shekel is twenty gerahs§);
half a shekel for an offering to Yahweh.
14 Everyone who passes over to those
who are counted, from twenty years old
and upward, shall give the offering to
Yahweh.
15 The rich shall not give more, and the
poor shall not give less, than the half
shekel,† when they give the offering of
Yahweh, to make atonement for your
souls.
16 You shall take the atonement money
from the children of Israel, and shall
appoint it for the service of the Tent of
Meeting; that it may be a memorial for the
children of Israel before Yahweh, to make
atonement for your souls."
17 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
18 "You shall also make a basin of
bronze, and its base of bronze, in which to
wash. You shall put it between the Tent of
Meeting and the altar, and you shall put
water in it.
19 Aaron and his sons shall wash their
hands and their feet in it.
20 When they go into the Tent of
Meeting, they shall wash with water, that
they don't die; or when they come near to
the altar to minister, to burn an offering
made by fire to Yahweh.
21 So they shall wash their hands and
their feet, that they not die. This shall be a
statute forever to them, even to him and
to his descendants throughout their
generations."

† **30:2** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. ‡ **30:13** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. § **30:13** a gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains † **30:15** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

22 Moreover Yahweh spoke to Moses,
saying,
23 "Also take fine spices: of liquid
myrrh, five hundred shekels;‡ and of
fragrant cinnamon half as much, even
two hundred and fifty; and of fragrant
cane, two hundred and fifty;
24 and of cassia five hundred, according
to the shekel of the sanctuary; and a hin§
of olive oil.
25 You shall make it into a holy
anointing oil, a perfume compounded
after the art of the perfumer: it shall be a
holy anointing oil.
26 You shall use it to anoint the Tent of
Meeting, the ark of the covenant,
27 the table and all its articles, the lamp
stand and its accessories, the altar of
incense,
28 the altar of burnt offering with all its
utensils, and the basin with its base.
29 You shall sanctify them, that they may
be most holy. Whatever touches them
shall be holy.
30 You shall anoint Aaron and his sons,
and sanctify them, that they may minister
to me in the priest's office.
31 You shall speak to the children of
Israel, saying, 'This shall be a holy
anointing oil to me throughout your
generations.
32 It shall not be poured on man's flesh,
and do not make any like it, according to
its composition. It is holy. It shall be holy
to you.
33 Whoever compounds any like it, or
whoever puts any of it on a stranger, he
shall be cut off from his people.' "
34 Yahweh said to Moses, "Take to
yourself sweet spices, gum resin, onycha,
and galbanum: sweet spices with pure
frankincense. There shall be an equal
weight of each.
35 You shall make incense of it, a
perfume after the art of the perfumer,
seasoned with salt, pure and holy.
36 You shall beat some of it very small,
and put some of it before the covenant in
the Tent of Meeting, where I will meet
with you. It shall be to you most holy.
37 You shall not make this incense,
according to its composition, for
yourselves: it shall be to you holy for
Yahweh.
38 Whoever shall make any like that, to
smell of it, he shall be cut off from his
people."

31

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Behold, I have called by name Bezalel
the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of the tribe
of Judah.
3 I have filled him with the Spirit of God,
in wisdom, and in understanding, and in
knowledge, and in all kinds of
workmanship,
4 to devise skillful works, to work in
gold, and in silver, and in bronze,
5 and in cutting of stones for setting, and
in carving of wood, to work in all kinds of
workmanship.
6 Behold, I myself have appointed with
him Oholiab, the son of Ahisamach, of the
tribe of Dan; and in the heart of all who
are wise-hearted I have put wisdom, that
they may make all that I have
commanded you:
7 the Tent of Meeting, the ark of the
covenant, the mercy seat that is on it, all
the furniture of the Tent,
8 the table and its vessels, the pure lamp
stand with all its vessels, the altar of
incense,
9 the altar of burnt offering with all its
vessels, the basin and its base,
10 the finely worked garments—the holy
garments for Aaron the priest, the
garments of his sons to minister in the
priest's office—
11 the anointing oil, and the incense of
sweet spices for the holy place: according
to all that I have commanded you they
shall do."
12 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
13 "Speak also to the children of Israel,
saying, 'Most certainly you shall keep my

‡ **30:23** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 500 shekels is about 5 kilograms or about 11 pounds.
§ **30:24** A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

Sabbaths; for it is a sign between me and you throughout your generations, that you may know that I am Yahweh who sanctifies you.
14 You shall keep the Sabbath therefore, for it is holy to you. Everyone who profanes it shall surely be put to death; for whoever does any work therein, that soul shall be cut off from among his people.
15 Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day is a Sabbath of solemn rest, holy to Yahweh. Whoever does any work on the Sabbath day shall surely be put to death.
16 Therefore the children of Israel shall keep the Sabbath, to observe the Sabbath throughout their generations, for a perpetual covenant.
17 It is a sign between me and the children of Israel forever; for in six days Yahweh made heaven and earth, and on the seventh day he rested, and was refreshed.' "
18 When he finished speaking with him on Mount Sinai, he gave Moses the two tablets of the covenant, stone tablets, written with God's finger.

32

1 When the people saw that Moses delayed coming down from the mountain, the people gathered themselves together to Aaron, and said to him, "Come, make us gods, which shall go before us; for as for this Moses, the man who brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we don't know what has become of him."
2 Aaron said to them, "Take off the golden rings, which are in the ears of your wives, of your sons, and of your daughters, and bring them to me."
3 All the people took off the golden rings which were in their ears, and brought them to Aaron.
4 He received what they handed him, fashioned it with an engraving tool, and made it a molded calf. Then they said, "These are your gods, Israel, which brought you up out of the land of Egypt."
5 When Aaron saw this, he built an altar before it; and Aaron made a proclamation, and said, "Tomorrow shall be a feast to Yahweh."
6 They rose up early on the next day, and offered burnt offerings, and brought peace offerings; and the people sat down to eat and to drink, and rose up to play.
7 Yahweh spoke to Moses, "Go, get down; for your people, whom you brought up out of the land of Egypt, have corrupted themselves!
8 They have turned away quickly out of the way which I commanded them. They have made themselves a molded calf, and have worshiped it, and have sacrificed to it, and said, 'These are your gods, Israel, which brought you up out of the land of Egypt.' "
9 Yahweh said to Moses, "I have seen these people, and behold, they are a stiff-necked people.
10 Now therefore leave me alone, that my wrath may burn hot against them, and that I may consume them; and I will make of you a great nation."
11 Moses begged Yahweh his God, and said, "Yahweh, why does your wrath burn hot against your people, that you have brought out of the land of Egypt with great power and with a mighty hand?
12 Why should the Egyptians talk, saying, 'He brought them out for evil, to kill them in the mountains, and to consume them from the surface of the earth'? Turn from your fierce wrath, and turn away from this evil against your people.
13 Remember Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, your servants, to whom you swore by your own self, and said to them, 'I will multiply your offspring† as the stars of the sky, and all this land that I have spoken of I will give to your offspring, and they shall inherit it forever.' "
14 So Yahweh turned away from the evil which he said he would do to his people.
15 Moses turned, and went down from the mountain, with the two tablets of the covenant in his hand; tablets that were

† **32:13** or, seed

written on both their sides. They were written on one side and on the other.
16 The tablets were the work of God, and the writing was the writing of God, engraved on the tablets.
17 When Joshua heard the noise of the people as they shouted, he said to Moses, “There is the noise of war in the camp.”
18 He said, “It isn’t the voice of those who shout for victory. It is not the voice of those who cry for being overcome; but the noise of those who sing that I hear.”
19 As soon as he came near to the camp, he saw the calf and the dancing. Then Moses’ anger grew hot, and he threw the tablets out of his hands, and broke them beneath the mountain.
20 He took the calf which they had made, and burned it with fire, ground it to powder, and scattered it on the water, and made the children of Israel drink it.
21 Moses said to Aaron, “What did these people do to you, that you have brought a great sin on them?”
22 Aaron said, “Don’t let the anger of my lord grow hot. You know the people, that they are set on evil.
23 For they said to me, ‘Make us gods, which shall go before us. As for this Moses, the man who brought us up out of the land of Egypt, we don’t know what has become of him.’
24 I said to them, ‘Whoever has any gold, let them take it off.’ So they gave it to me; and I threw it into the fire, and out came this calf.”
25 When Moses saw that the people were out of control, (for Aaron had let them lose control, causing derision among their enemies),
26 then Moses stood in the gate of the camp, and said, “Whoever is on Yahweh’s side, come to me!”
All the sons of Levi gathered themselves together to him.
27 He said to them, “Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, ‘Every man put his sword on his thigh, and go back and forth from gate to gate throughout the camp, and every man kill his brother, and every man his companion, and every man his neighbor.’ ”
28 The sons of Levi did according to the word of Moses. About three thousand men fell of the people that day.
29 Moses said, “Consecrate yourselves today to Yahweh, for every man was against his son and against his brother, that he may give you a blessing today.”
30 On the next day, Moses said to the people, “You have sinned a great sin. Now I will go up to Yahweh. Perhaps I shall make atonement for your sin.”
31 Moses returned to Yahweh, and said, “Oh, this people have sinned a great sin, and have made themselves gods of gold.
32 Yet now, if you will, forgive their sin—and if not, please blot me out of your book which you have written.”
33 Yahweh said to Moses, “Whoever has sinned against me, I will blot him out of my book.
34 Now go, lead the people to the place of which I have spoken to you. Behold, my angel shall go before you. Nevertheless, in the day when I punish, I will punish them for their sin.”
35 Yahweh struck the people, because of what they did with the calf, which Aaron made.

33

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, “Depart, go up from here, you and the people that you have brought up out of the land of Egypt, to the land of which I swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, saying, ‘I will give it to your offspring.’
2 I will send an angel before you; and I will drive out the Canaanite, the Amorite, and the Hittite, and the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite.
3 Go to a land flowing with milk and honey; but I will not go up among you, for you are a stiff-necked people, lest I consume you on the way.”
4 When the people heard this evil news, they mourned; and no one put on his jewelry.
5 Yahweh had said to Moses, “Tell the children of Israel, ‘You are a stiff-necked people. If I were to go up among you for one moment, I would consume you.

Therefore now take off your jewelry from you, that I may know what to do to you.' "
6 The children of Israel stripped themselves of their jewelry from Mount Horeb onward.
7 Now Moses used to take the tent and pitch it outside the camp, far away from the camp, and he called it "The Tent of Meeting." Everyone who sought Yahweh went out to the Tent of Meeting, which was outside the camp.
8 When Moses went out to the Tent, all the people rose up, and stood, everyone at their tent door, and watched Moses, until he had gone into the Tent.
9 When Moses entered into the Tent, the pillar of cloud descended, stood at the door of the Tent, and Yahweh spoke with Moses.
10 All the people saw the pillar of cloud stand at the door of the Tent, and all the people rose up and worshiped, everyone at their tent door.
11 Yahweh spoke to Moses face to face, as a man speaks to his friend. He turned again into the camp, but his servant Joshua, the son of Nun, a young man, didn't depart from the Tent.
12 Moses said to Yahweh, "Behold, you tell me, 'Bring up this people;' and you haven't let me know whom you will send with me. Yet you have said, 'I know you by name, and you have also found favor in my sight.'
13 Now therefore, if I have found favor in your sight, please show me your way, now, that I may know you, so that I may find favor in your sight; and consider that this nation is your people."
14 He said, "My presence will go with you, and I will give you rest."
15 Moses said to him, "If your presence doesn't go with me, don't carry us up from here.
16 For how would people know that I have found favor in your sight, I and your people? Isn't it that you go with us, so that we are separated, I and your people, from all the people who are on the surface of the earth?"
17 Yahweh said to Moses, "I will do this thing also that you have spoken; for you have found favor in my sight, and I know you by name."
18 Moses said, "Please show me your glory."
19 He said, "I will make all my goodness pass before you, and will proclaim Yahweh's name before you. I will be gracious to whom I will be gracious, and will show mercy on whom I will show mercy."
20 He said, "You cannot see my face, for man may not see me and live."
21 Yahweh also said, "Behold, there is a place by me, and you shall stand on the rock.
22 It will happen, while my glory passes by, that I will put you in a cleft of the rock, and will cover you with my hand until I have passed by;
23 then I will take away my hand, and you will see my back; but my face shall not be seen."

34

1 Yahweh said to Moses, "Chisel two stone tablets like the first. I will write on the tablets the words that were on the first tablets, which you broke.
2 Be ready by the morning, and come up in the morning to Mount Sinai, and present yourself there to me on the top of the mountain.
3 No one shall come up with you or be seen anywhere on the mountain. Do not let the flocks or herds graze in front of that mountain."
4 He chiseled two tablets of stone like the first; then Moses rose up early in the morning, and went up to Mount Sinai, as Yahweh had commanded him, and took in his hand two stone tablets.
5 Yahweh descended in the cloud, and stood with him there, and proclaimed Yahweh's name.
6 Yahweh passed by before him, and proclaimed, "Yahweh! Yahweh, a merciful and gracious God, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness and truth,
7 keeping loving kindness for thousands, forgiving iniquity and disobedience and sin; and who will by no means clear the guilty, visiting the

iniquity of the fathers on the children,
and on the children's children, on the
third and on the fourth generation."
8 Moses hurried and bowed his head
toward the earth, and worshiped.
9 He said, "If now I have found favor in
your sight, Lord, please let the Lord go
among us, even though this is a
stiff-necked people; pardon our iniquity
and our sin, and take us for your
inheritance."
10 He said, "Behold, I make a covenant:
before all your people I will do marvels,
such as have not been worked in all the
earth, nor in any nation; and all the
people among whom you are shall see the
work of Yahweh; for it is an awesome
thing that I do with you.
11 Observe that which I command you
today. Behold, I will drive out before you
the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Hittite, the
Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite.
12 Be careful, lest you make a covenant
with the inhabitants of the land where
you are going, lest it be for a snare among
you;
13 but you shall break down their altars,
and dash in pieces their pillars, and you
shall cut down their Asherah poles;
14 for you shall worship no other god;
for Yahweh, whose name is Jealous, is a
jealous God.
15 "Don't make a covenant with the
inhabitants of the land, lest they play the
prostitute after their gods, and sacrifice to
their gods, and one call you and you eat of
his sacrifice;
16 and you take of their daughters to
your sons, and their daughters play the
prostitute after their gods, and make your
sons play the prostitute after their gods.
17 "You shall make no cast idols for
yourselves.
18 "You shall keep the feast of
unleavened bread. Seven days you shall
eat unleavened bread, as I commanded
you, at the time appointed in the month
Abib; for in the month Abib you came out
of Egypt.
19 "All that opens the womb is mine; and
all your livestock that is male, the
firstborn of cow and sheep.
20 You shall redeem the firstborn of a
donkey with a lamb. If you will not
redeem it, then you shall break its neck.
You shall redeem all the firstborn of your
sons. No one shall appear before me
empty.
21 "Six days you shall work, but on the
seventh day you shall rest: in plowing
time and in harvest you shall rest.
22 "You shall observe the feast of weeks
with the first fruits of wheat harvest, and
the feast of harvest at the year's end.
23 Three times in the year all your males
shall appear before the Lord Yahweh, the
God of Israel.
24 For I will drive out nations before you
and enlarge your borders; neither shall
any man desire your land when you go up
to appear before Yahweh, your God, three
times in the year.
25 "You shall not offer the blood of my
sacrifice with leavened bread. The
sacrifice of the feast of the Passover shall
not be left to the morning.
26 "You shall bring the first of the first
fruits of your ground to the house of
Yahweh your God.
"You shall not boil a young goat in its
mother's milk."
27 Yahweh said to Moses, "Write these
words; for in accordance with these
words I have made a covenant with you
and with Israel."
28 He was there with Yahweh forty days
and forty nights; he neither ate bread, nor
drank water. He wrote on the tablets the
words of the covenant, the ten
commandments.
29 When Moses came down from Mount
Sinai with the two tablets of the covenant
in Moses' hand, when he came down from
the mountain, Moses didn't know that the
skin of his face shone by reason of his
speaking with him.
30 When Aaron and all the children of
Israel saw Moses, behold, the skin of his
face shone; and they were afraid to come
near him.
31 Moses called to them, and Aaron and
all the rulers of the congregation returned
to him; and Moses spoke to them.
32 Afterward all the children of Israel
came near, and he gave them all the

commandments that Yahweh had spoken with him on Mount Sinai.
33 When Moses was done speaking with them, he put a veil on his face.
34 But when Moses went in before Yahweh to speak with him, he took the veil off, until he came out; and he came out, and spoke to the children of Israel that which he was commanded.
35 The children of Israel saw Moses' face, that the skin of Moses' face shone; so Moses put the veil on his face again, until he went in to speak with him.

35

1 Moses assembled all the congregation of the children of Israel, and said to them, "These are the words which Yahweh has commanded, that you should do them.
2 'Six days shall work be done, but on the seventh day there shall be a holy day for you, a Sabbath of solemn rest to Yahweh: whoever does any work in it shall be put to death.
3 You shall kindle no fire throughout your habitations on the Sabbath day.' "
4 Moses spoke to all the congregation of the children of Israel, saying, "This is the thing which Yahweh commanded, saying,
5 'Take from among you an offering to Yahweh. Whoever is of a willing heart, let him bring it as Yahweh's offering: gold, silver, bronze,
6 blue, purple, scarlet, fine linen, goats' hair,
7 rams' skins dyed red, sea cow hides, acacia wood,
8 oil for the light, spices for the anointing oil and for the sweet incense,
9 onyx stones, and stones to be set for the ephod and for the breastplate.
10 " 'Let every wise-hearted man among you come, and make all that Yahweh has commanded:
11 the tabernacle, its outer covering, its roof, its clasps, its boards, its bars, its pillars, and its sockets;
12 the ark, and its poles, the mercy seat, the veil of the screen;
13 the table with its poles and all its vessels, and the show bread;
14 the lamp stand also for the light, with its vessels, its lamps, and the oil for the light;
15 and the altar of incense with its poles, the anointing oil, the sweet incense, the screen for the door, at the door of the tabernacle;
16 the altar of burnt offering, with its grating of bronze, its poles, and all its vessels, the basin and its base;
17 the hangings of the court, its pillars, their sockets, and the screen for the gate of the court;
18 the pins of the tabernacle, the pins of the court, and their cords;
19 the finely worked garments for ministering in the holy place—the holy garments for Aaron the priest, and the garments of his sons—to minister in the priest's office.' "
20 All the congregation of the children of Israel departed from the presence of Moses.
21 They came, everyone whose heart stirred him up, and everyone whom his spirit made willing, and brought Yahweh's offering for the work of the Tent of Meeting, and for all of its service, and for the holy garments.
22 They came, both men and women, as many as were willing-hearted, and brought brooches, earrings, signet rings, and armlets, all jewels of gold; even every man who offered an offering of gold to Yahweh.
23 Everyone with whom was found blue, purple, scarlet, fine linen, goats' hair, rams' skins dyed red, and sea cow hides, brought them.
24 Everyone who offered an offering of silver and bronze brought Yahweh's offering; and everyone with whom was found acacia wood for any work of the service, brought it.
25 All the women who were wise-hearted spun with their hands, and brought that which they had spun: the blue, the purple, the scarlet, and the fine linen.
26 All the women whose heart stirred them up in wisdom spun the goats' hair.

27 The rulers brought the onyx stones
and the stones to be set for the ephod and
for the breastplate;
28 with the spice and the oil for the light,
for the anointing oil, and for the sweet
incense.
29 The children of Israel brought a free
will offering to Yahweh; every man and
woman whose heart made them willing to
bring for all the work, which Yahweh had
commanded to be made by Moses.
30 Moses said to the children of Israel,
"Behold, Yahweh has called by name
Bezalel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, of
the tribe of Judah.
31 He has filled him with the Spirit of
God, in wisdom, in understanding, in
knowledge, and in all kinds of
workmanship;
32 and to make skillful works, to work in
gold, in silver, in bronze,
33 in cutting of stones for setting, and in
carving of wood, to work in all kinds of
skillful workmanship.
34 He has put in his heart that he may
teach, both he and Oholiab, the son of
Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan.
35 He has filled them with wisdom of
heart to work all kinds of workmanship,
of the engraver, of the skillful workman,
and of the embroiderer, in blue, in purple,
in scarlet, and in fine linen, and of the
weaver, even of those who do any
workmanship, and of those who make
skillful works.

36

1 "Bezalel and Oholiab shall work with
every wise-hearted man, in whom
Yahweh has put wisdom and
understanding to know how to do all the
work for the service of the sanctuary,
according to all that Yahweh has
commanded."
2 Moses called Bezalel and Oholiab, and
every wise-hearted man, in whose heart
Yahweh had put wisdom, even everyone
whose heart stirred him up to come to the
work to do it.
3 They received from Moses all the
offering which the children of Israel had
brought for the work of the service of the
sanctuary, with which to make it. They
kept bringing free will offerings to him
every morning.
4 All the wise men, who performed all
the work of the sanctuary, each came
from his work which he did.
5 They spoke to Moses, saying, "The
people have brought much more than
enough for the service of the work which
Yahweh commanded to make."
6 Moses gave a commandment, and they
caused it to be proclaimed throughout the
camp, saying, "Let neither man nor
woman make anything else for the
offering for the sanctuary." So the people
were restrained from bringing.
7 For the stuff they had was sufficient to
do all the work, and too much.
8 All the wise-hearted men among those
who did the work made the tabernacle
with ten curtains of fine twined linen,
blue, purple, and scarlet. They made them
with cherubim, the work of a skillful
workman.
9 The length of each curtain was
twenty-eight cubits,† and the width of
each curtain four cubits. All the curtains
had one measure.
10 He coupled five curtains to one
another, and the other five curtains he
coupled to one another.
11 He made loops of blue on the edge of
the one curtain from the edge in the
coupling. Likewise he made in the edge of
the curtain that was outermost in the
second coupling.
12 He made fifty loops in the one curtain,
and he made fifty loops in the edge of the
curtain that was in the second coupling.
The loops were opposite to one another.
13 He made fifty clasps of gold, and
coupled the curtains to one another with
the clasps: so the tabernacle was a unit.
14 He made curtains of goats' hair for a
covering over the tabernacle. He made
them eleven curtains.

† **36:9** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

15 The length of each curtain was thirty
cubits, and four cubits the width of each
curtain. The eleven curtains had one
measure.
16 He coupled five curtains by
themselves, and six curtains by
themselves.
17 He made fifty loops on the edge of the
curtain that was outermost in the
coupling, and he made fifty loops on the
edge of the curtain which was outermost
in the second coupling.
18 He made fifty clasps of bronze to
couple the tent together, that it might be a
unit.
19 He made a covering for the tent of
rams' skins dyed red, and a covering of
sea cow hides above.
20 He made the boards for the
tabernacle of acacia wood, standing up.
21 Ten cubits was the length of a board,
and a cubit and a half the width of each
board.
22 Each board had two tenons, joined to
one another. He made all the boards of
the tabernacle this way.
23 He made the boards for the
tabernacle, twenty boards for the south
side southward.
24 He made forty sockets of silver under
the twenty boards: two sockets under one
board for its two tenons, and two sockets
under another board for its two tenons.
25 For the second side of the tabernacle,
on the north side, he made twenty boards
26 and their forty sockets of silver: two
sockets under one board, and two sockets
under another board.
27 For the far part of the tabernacle
westward he made six boards.
28 He made two boards for the corners
of the tabernacle in the far part.
29 They were double beneath, and in the
same way they were all the way to its top
to one ring. He did this to both of them in
the two corners.
30 There were eight boards and their
sockets of silver, sixteen sockets—under
every board two sockets.
31 He made bars of acacia wood: five for
the boards of the one side of the
tabernacle,
32 and five bars for the boards of the
other side of the tabernacle, and five bars
for the boards of the tabernacle for the
hinder part westward.
33 He made the middle bar to pass
through in the middle of the boards from
the one end to the other.
34 He overlaid the boards with gold, and
made their rings of gold as places for the
bars, and overlaid the bars with gold.
35 He made the veil of blue, purple,
scarlet, and fine twined linen, with
cherubim. He made it the work of a
skillful workman.
36 He made four pillars of acacia for it,
and overlaid them with gold. Their hooks
were of gold. He cast four sockets of silver
for them.
37 He made a screen for the door of the
tent, of blue, purple, scarlet, and fine
twined linen, the work of an embroiderer;
38 and the five pillars of it with their
hooks. He overlaid their capitals and their
fillets with gold, and their five sockets
were of bronze.

37

1 Bezalel made the ark of acacia wood.
Its length was two and a half cubits,† and
its width a cubit and a half, and a cubit
and a half its height.
2 He overlaid it with pure gold inside
and outside, and made a molding of gold
for it around it.
3 He cast four rings of gold for it in its
four feet—two rings on its one side, and
two rings on its other side.
4 He made poles of acacia wood and
overlaid them with gold.
5 He put the poles into the rings on the
sides of the ark, to bear the ark.
6 He made a mercy seat of pure gold. Its
length was two and a half cubits, and a
cubit and a half its width.
7 He made two cherubim of gold. He
made them of beaten work, at the two
ends of the mercy seat:
8 one cherub at the one end, and one
cherub at the other end. He made the
cherubim of one piece with the mercy
seat at its two ends.

† **37:1** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

9 The cherubim spread out their wings
above, covering the mercy seat with their
wings, with their faces toward one
another. The faces of the cherubim were
toward the mercy seat.

10 He made the table of acacia wood. Its
length was two cubits, and its width was a
cubit, and its height was a cubit and a half.
11 He overlaid it with pure gold, and
made a gold molding around it.
12 He made a border of a hand's width
around it, and made a golden molding on
its border around it.
13 He cast four rings of gold for it, and
put the rings in the four corners that were
on its four feet.
14 The rings were close by the border,
the places for the poles to carry the table.
15 He made the poles of acacia wood,
and overlaid them with gold, to carry the
table.
16 He made the vessels which were on
the table, its dishes, its spoons, its bowls,
and its pitchers with which to pour out, of
pure gold.

17 He made the lamp stand of pure gold.
He made the lamp stand of beaten work.
Its base, its shaft, its cups, its buds, and its
flowers were of one piece with it.
18 There were six branches going out of
its sides: three branches of the lamp stand
out of its one side, and three branches of
the lamp stand out of its other side:
19 three cups made like almond
blossoms in one branch, a bud and a
flower, and three cups made like almond
blossoms in the other branch, a bud and a
flower; so for the six branches going out
of the lamp stand.
20 In the lamp stand were four cups
made like almond blossoms, its buds and
its flowers;
21 and a bud under two branches of one
piece with it, and a bud under two
branches of one piece with it, and a bud
under two branches of one piece with it,
for the six branches going out of it.
22 Their buds and their branches were
of one piece with it. The whole thing was
one beaten work of pure gold.
23 He made its seven lamps, and its
snuffers, and its snuff dishes, of pure gold.
24 He made it of a talent‡ of pure gold,
with all its vessels.
25 He made the altar of incense of acacia
wood. It was square: its length was a
cubit, and its width a cubit. Its height was
two cubits. Its horns were of one piece
with it.
26 He overlaid it with pure gold: its top,
its sides around it, and its horns. He made
a gold molding around it.
27 He made two golden rings for it under
its molding crown, on its two ribs, on its
two sides, for places for poles with which
to carry it.
28 He made the poles of acacia wood,
and overlaid them with gold.
29 He made the holy anointing oil and
the pure incense of sweet spices, after the
art of the perfumer.

38

1 He made the altar of burnt offering of
acacia wood. It was square. Its length was
five cubits,† its width was five cubits, and
its height was three cubits.
2 He made its horns on its four corners.
Its horns were of one piece with it, and he
overlaid it with bronze.
3 He made all the vessels of the altar: the
pots, the shovels, the basins, the forks,
and the fire pans. He made all its vessels
of bronze.
4 He made for the altar a grating of a
network of bronze, under the ledge
around it beneath, reaching halfway up.
5 He cast four rings for the four corners
of bronze grating, to be places for the
poles.
6 He made the poles of acacia wood, and
overlaid them with bronze.
7 He put the poles into the rings on the
sides of the altar, with which to carry it.
He made it hollow with planks.
8 He made the basin of bronze, and its
base of bronze, out of the mirrors of the
ministering women who ministered at the
door of the Tent of Meeting.

‡ **37:24** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces † **38:1** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

9 He made the court: for the south side
southward the hangings of the court were
of fine twined linen, one hundred cubits;
10 their pillars were twenty, and their
sockets twenty, of bronze; the hooks of the
pillars and their fillets were of silver.
11 For the north side one hundred
cubits, their pillars twenty, and their
sockets twenty, of bronze; the hooks of the
pillars, and their fillets, of silver.
12 For the west side were hangings of
fifty cubits, their pillars ten, and their
sockets ten; the hooks of the pillars, and
their fillets, of silver.
13 For the east side eastward fifty cubits,
14 the hangings for the one side were
fifteen cubits; their pillars three, and their
sockets three;
15 and so for the other side: on this hand
and that hand by the gate of the court
were hangings of fifteen cubits; their
pillars three, and their sockets three.
16 All the hangings around the court
were of fine twined linen.
17 The sockets for the pillars were of
bronze. The hooks of the pillars and their
fillets were of silver. Their capitals were
overlaid with silver. All the pillars of the
court had silver bands.
18 The screen for the gate of the court
was the work of the embroiderer, of blue,
purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen.
Twenty cubits was the length, and the
height along the width was five cubits,
like the hangings of the court.
19 Their pillars were four, and their
sockets four, of bronze; their hooks of
silver, and the overlaying of their capitals,
and their fillets, of silver.
20 All the pins of the tabernacle, and
around the court, were of bronze.
21 These are the amounts of materials
used for the tabernacle, even the
Tabernacle of the Testimony, as they were
counted, according to the commandment
of Moses, for the service of the Levites, by
the hand of Ithamar, the son of Aaron the
priest.
22 Bezalel the son of Uri, the son of Hur,
of the tribe of Judah, made all that
Yahweh commanded Moses.
23 With him was Oholiab, the son of
Ahisamach, of the tribe of Dan, an
engraver, and a skillful workman, and an
embroiderer in blue, in purple, in scarlet,
and in fine linen.
24 All the gold that was used for the
work in all the work of the sanctuary,
even the gold of the offering, was
twenty-nine talents‡ and seven hundred
thirty shekels, according to the shekel§ of
the sanctuary.
25 The silver of those who were counted
of the congregation was one hundred
talents† and one thousand seven hundred
seventy-five shekels,‡ according to the
shekel of the sanctuary:
26 a beka§ a head, that is, half a shekel,
according to the shekel† of the sanctuary,
for everyone who passed over to those
who were counted, from twenty years old
and upward, for six hundred three
thousand five hundred fifty men.
27 The one hundred talents‡ of silver
were for casting the sockets of the
sanctuary and the sockets of the veil: one
hundred sockets for the one hundred
talents, one talent per socket.
28 From the one thousand seven
hundred seventy-five shekels§ he made
hooks for the pillars, overlaid their
capitals, and made fillets for them.
29 The bronze of the offering was
seventy talents† and two thousand four
hundred shekels.‡
30 With this he made the sockets to the
door of the Tent of Meeting, the bronze
altar, the bronze grating for it, all the
vessels of the altar,
31 the sockets around the court, the
sockets of the gate of the court, all the pins

‡ **38:24** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces. § **38:24** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces. † **38:25** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds ‡ **38:25** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. § **38:26** a beka is about 5 grams or about 0.175 ounces † **38:26** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. ‡ **38:27** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds. § **38:28** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1775 shekels is about 17.75 kilograms or about 39 pounds. † **38:29** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds ‡ **38:29** 70 talents + 2400 shekels is about 2124 kilograms, or 2.124 metric tons.

of the tabernacle, and all the pins around the court.

39

1 Of the blue, purple, and scarlet, they made finely worked garments for ministering in the holy place, and made the holy garments for Aaron, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
2 He made the ephod of gold, blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen.
3 They beat the gold into thin plates, and cut it into wires, to work it in with the blue, the purple, the scarlet, and the fine linen, the work of the skillful workman.
4 They made shoulder straps for it, joined together. It was joined together at the two ends.
5 The skillfully woven band that was on it, with which to fasten it on, was of the same piece, like its work: of gold, of blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
6 They worked the onyx stones, enclosed in settings of gold, engraved with the engravings of a signet, according to the names of the children of Israel.
7 He put them on the shoulder straps of the ephod, to be stones of memorial for the children of Israel, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
8 He made the breastplate, the work of a skillful workman, like the work of the ephod: of gold, of blue, purple, scarlet, and fine twined linen.
9 It was square. They made the breastplate double. Its length was a span,† and its width a span, being double.
10 They set in it four rows of stones. A row of ruby, topaz, and beryl was the first row;
11 and the second row, a turquoise, a sapphire,‡ and an emerald;
12 and the third row, a jacinth, an agate, and an amethyst;
13 and the fourth row, a chrysolite, an onyx, and a jasper. They were enclosed in gold settings.
14 The stones were according to the names of the children of Israel, twelve, according to their names; like the engravings of a signet, everyone according to his name, for the twelve tribes.
15 They made on the breastplate chains like cords, of braided work of pure gold.
16 They made two settings of gold, and two gold rings, and put the two rings on the two ends of the breastplate.
17 They put the two braided chains of gold in the two rings at the ends of the breastplate.
18 The other two ends of the two braided chains they put on the two settings, and put them on the shoulder straps of the ephod, in its front.
19 They made two rings of gold, and put them on the two ends of the breastplate, on its edge, which was toward the side of the ephod inward.
20 They made two more rings of gold, and put them on the two shoulder straps of the ephod underneath, in its front, close by its coupling, above the skillfully woven band of the ephod.
21 They bound the breastplate by its rings to the rings of the ephod with a lace of blue, that it might be on the skillfully woven band of the ephod, and that the breastplate might not come loose from the ephod, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
22 He made the robe of the ephod of woven work, all of blue.
23 The opening of the robe in the middle of it was like the opening of a coat of mail, with a binding around its opening, that it should not be torn.
24 They made on the skirts of the robe pomegranates of blue, purple, scarlet, and twined linen.
25 They made bells of pure gold, and put the bells between the pomegranates around the skirts of the robe, between the pomegranates;
26 a bell and a pomegranate, a bell and a pomegranate, around the skirts of the robe, to minister in, as Yahweh commanded Moses.

† **39:9** A span is the length from the tip of a man's thumb to the tip of his little finger when his hand is stretched out (about half a cubit, or 9 inches, or 22.8 cm.) ‡ **39:11** or, lapis lazuli

27 They made the tunics of fine linen of
woven work for Aaron and for his sons,
28 the turban of fine linen, the linen
headbands of fine linen, the linen
trousers of fine twined linen,
29 the sash of fine twined linen, blue,
purple, and scarlet, the work of the
embroiderer, as Yahweh commanded
Moses.
30 They made the plate of the holy
crown of pure gold, and wrote on it an
inscription, like the engravings of a signet:
“HOLY TO YAHWEH”.
31 They tied to it a lace of blue, to fasten
it on the turban above, as Yahweh
commanded Moses.
32 Thus all the work of the tabernacle of
the Tent of Meeting was finished. The
children of Israel did according to all that
Yahweh commanded Moses; so they did.
33 They brought the tabernacle to
Moses: the tent, with all its furniture, its
clasps, its boards, its bars, its pillars, its
sockets,
34 the covering of rams’ skins dyed red,
the covering of sea cow hides, the veil of
the screen,
35 the ark of the covenant with its poles,
the mercy seat,
36 the table, all its vessels, the show
bread,
37 the pure lamp stand, its lamps, even
the lamps to be set in order, all its vessels,
the oil for the light,
38 the golden altar, the anointing oil, the
sweet incense, the screen for the door of
the Tent,
39 the bronze altar, its grating of bronze,
its poles, all of its vessels, the basin and its
base,
40 the hangings of the court, its pillars,
its sockets, the screen for the gate of the
court, its cords, its pins, and all the
instruments of the service of the
tabernacle, for the Tent of Meeting,
41 the finely worked garments for
ministering in the holy place, the holy
garments for Aaron the priest, and the
garments of his sons, to minister in the
priest’s office.
42 According to all that Yahweh
commanded Moses, so the children of
Israel did all the work.
43 Moses saw all the work, and behold,
they had done it as Yahweh had
commanded. They had done so; and
Moses blessed them.

40

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 “On the first day of the first month you
shall raise up the tabernacle of the Tent of
Meeting.
3 You shall put the ark of the covenant in
it, and you shall screen the ark with the
veil.
4 You shall bring in the table, and set in
order the things that are on it. You shall
bring in the lamp stand, and light its
lamps.
5 You shall set the golden altar for
incense before the ark of the covenant,
and put the screen of the door to the
tabernacle.
6 “You shall set the altar of burnt
offering before the door of the tabernacle
of the Tent of Meeting.
7 You shall set the basin between the
Tent of Meeting and the altar, and shall
put water therein.
8 You shall set up the court around it,
and hang up the screen of the gate of the
court.
9 “You shall take the anointing oil, and
anoint the tabernacle and all that is in it,
and shall make it holy, and all its
furniture, and it will be holy.
10 You shall anoint the altar of burnt
offering, with all its vessels, and sanctify
the altar, and the altar will be most holy.
11 You shall anoint the basin and its
base, and sanctify it.
12 “You shall bring Aaron and his sons to
the door of the Tent of Meeting, and shall
wash them with water.
13 You shall put on Aaron the holy
garments; and you shall anoint him, and
sanctify him, that he may minister to me
in the priest’s office.
14 You shall bring his sons, and put
tunics on them.
15 You shall anoint them, as you
anointed their father, that they may
minister to me in the priest’s office. Their
anointing shall be to them for an

everlasting priesthood throughout their generations."
16 Moses did so. According to all that Yahweh commanded him, so he did.
17 In the first month in the second year, on the first day of the month, the tabernacle was raised up.
18 Moses raised up the tabernacle, and laid its sockets, and set up its boards, and put in its bars, and raised up its pillars.
19 He spread the covering over the tent, and put the roof of the tabernacle above on it, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
20 He took and put the covenant into the ark, and set the poles on the ark, and put the mercy seat above on the ark.
21 He brought the ark into the tabernacle, and set up the veil of the screen, and screened the ark of the covenant, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
22 He put the table in the Tent of Meeting, on the north side of the tabernacle, outside of the veil.
23 He set the bread in order on it before Yahweh, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
24 He put the lamp stand in the Tent of Meeting, opposite the table, on the south side of the tabernacle.
25 He lit the lamps before Yahweh, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
26 He put the golden altar in the Tent of Meeting before the veil;
27 and he burned incense of sweet spices on it, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
28 He put up the screen of the door to the tabernacle.
29 He set the altar of burnt offering at the door of the tabernacle of the Tent of Meeting, and offered on it the burnt offering and the meal offering, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
30 He set the basin between the Tent of Meeting and the altar, and put water therein, with which to wash.
31 Moses, Aaron, and his sons washed their hands and their feet there.
32 When they went into the Tent of Meeting, and when they came near to the altar, they washed, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
33 He raised up the court around the tabernacle and the altar, and set up the screen of the gate of the court. So Moses finished the work.
34 Then the cloud covered the Tent of Meeting, and Yahweh's glory filled the tabernacle.
35 Moses wasn't able to enter into the Tent of Meeting, because the cloud stayed on it, and Yahweh's glory filled the tabernacle.
36 When the cloud was taken up from over the tabernacle, the children of Israel went onward, throughout all their journeys;
37 but if the cloud wasn't taken up, then they didn't travel until the day that it was taken up.
38 For the cloud of Yahweh was on the tabernacle by day, and there was fire in the cloud by night, in the sight of all the house of Israel, throughout all their journeys.

The Third Book of Moses, Commonly Called Leviticus

1 Yahweh† called to Moses, and spoke to
him from the Tent of Meeting, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them, 'When anyone of you offers an
offering to Yahweh, you shall offer your
offering of the livestock, from the herd
and from the flock.
3 " 'If his offering is a burnt offering
from the herd, he shall offer a male
without defect. He shall offer it at the
door of the Tent of Meeting, that he may
be accepted before Yahweh.
4 He shall lay his hand on the head of the
burnt offering, and it shall be accepted for
him to make atonement for him.
5 He shall kill the bull before Yahweh.
Aaron's sons, the priests, shall present the
blood and sprinkle the blood around on
the altar that is at the door of the Tent of
Meeting.
6 He shall skin the burnt offering and
cut it into pieces.
7 The sons of Aaron the priest shall put
fire on the altar, and lay wood in order on
the fire;
8 and Aaron's sons, the priests, shall lay
the pieces, the head, and the fat in order
on the wood that is on the fire which is on
the altar;
9 but he shall wash its innards and its
legs with water. The priest shall burn all
of it on the altar, for a burnt offering, an
offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma
to Yahweh.
10 " 'If his offering is from the flock,
from the sheep or from the goats, for a
burnt offering, he shall offer a male
without defect.
11 He shall kill it on the north side of the
altar before Yahweh. Aaron's sons, the
priests, shall sprinkle its blood around on
the altar.
12 He shall cut it into its pieces, with its
head and its fat. The priest shall lay them
in order on the wood that is on the fire
which is on the altar,
13 but the innards and the legs he shall
wash with water. The priest shall offer
the whole, and burn it on the altar. It is a
burnt offering, an offering made by fire,
of a pleasant aroma to Yahweh.
14 " 'If his offering to Yahweh is a burnt
offering of birds, then he shall offer his
offering from turtledoves or of young
pigeons.
15 The priest shall bring it to the altar,
and wring off its head, and burn it on the
altar; and its blood shall be drained out on
the side of the altar;
16 and he shall take away its crop and its
feathers, and cast it beside the altar on the
east part, in the place of the ashes.
17 He shall tear it by its wings, but shall
not divide it apart. The priest shall burn it
on the altar, on the wood that is on the
fire. It is a burnt offering, an offering
made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to
Yahweh.

2

1 " 'When anyone offers an offering of a
meal offering to Yahweh, his offering
shall be of fine flour. He shall pour oil on
it, and put frankincense on it.
2 He shall bring it to Aaron's sons, the
priests. He shall take his handful of its
fine flour, and of its oil, with all its
frankincense, and the priest shall burn its
memorial on the altar, an offering made
by fire, of a pleasant aroma to Yahweh.
3 That which is left of the meal offering
shall be Aaron's and his sons'. It is a most
holy part of the offerings of Yahweh made
by fire.
4 " 'When you offer an offering of a meal
offering baked in the oven, it shall be
unleavened cakes of fine flour mixed with
oil, or unleavened wafers anointed with
oil.
5 If your offering is a meal offering
made on a griddle, it shall be of
unleavened fine flour, mixed with oil.
6 You shall cut it in pieces, and pour oil
on it. It is a meal offering.

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations.

7 If your offering is a meal offering of
the pan, it shall be made of fine flour with
oil.
8 You shall bring the meal offering that
is made of these things to Yahweh. It shall
be presented to the priest, and he shall
bring it to the altar.
9 The priest shall take from the meal
offering its memorial, and shall burn it on
the altar, an offering made by fire, of a
pleasant aroma to Yahweh.
10 That which is left of the meal offering
shall be Aaron's and his sons'. It is a most
holy part of the offerings of Yahweh made
by fire.
11 " 'No meal offering which you shall
offer to Yahweh shall be made with yeast;
for you shall burn no yeast, nor any
honey, as an offering made by fire to
Yahweh.
12 As an offering of first fruits you shall
offer them to Yahweh, but they shall not
rise up as a pleasant aroma on the altar.
13 Every offering of your meal offering
you shall season with salt. You shall not
allow the salt of the covenant of your God†
to be lacking from your meal offering.
With all your offerings you shall offer salt.
14 " 'If you offer a meal offering of first
fruits to Yahweh, you shall offer for the
meal offering of your first fruits fresh
heads of grain parched with fire and
crushed.
15 You shall put oil on it and lay
frankincense on it. It is a meal offering.
16 The priest shall burn as its memorial
part of its crushed grain and part of its oil,
along with all its frankincense. It is an
offering made by fire to Yahweh.

3

1 " 'If his offering is a sacrifice of peace
offerings, if he offers it from the herd,
whether male or female, he shall offer it
without defect before Yahweh.
2 He shall lay his hand on the head of his
offering, and kill it at the door of the Tent
of Meeting. Aaron's sons, the priests, shall
sprinkle the blood around on the altar.
3 He shall offer of the sacrifice of peace
offerings an offering made by fire to
Yahweh. The fat that covers the innards,
and all the fat that is on the innards,
4 and the two kidneys, and the fat that is
on them, which is by the loins, and the
cover on the liver, with the kidneys, he
shall take away.
5 Aaron's sons shall burn it on the altar
on the burnt offering, which is on the
wood that is on the fire: it is an offering
made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to
Yahweh.
6 " 'If his offering for a sacrifice of peace
offerings to Yahweh is from the flock,
either male or female, he shall offer it
without defect.
7 If he offers a lamb for his offering,
then he shall offer it before Yahweh;
8 and he shall lay his hand on the head
of his offering, and kill it before the Tent
of Meeting. Aaron's sons shall sprinkle its
blood around on the altar.
9 He shall offer from the sacrifice of
peace offerings an offering made by fire
to Yahweh; its fat, the entire tail fat, he
shall take away close to the backbone; and
the fat that covers the entrails, and all the
fat that is on the entrails,
10 and the two kidneys, and the fat that
is on them, which is by the loins, and the
cover on the liver, with the kidneys, he
shall take away.
11 The priest shall burn it on the altar: it
is the food of the offering made by fire to
Yahweh.
12 " 'If his offering is a goat, then he shall
offer it before Yahweh.
13 He shall lay his hand on its head, and
kill it before the Tent of Meeting; and the
sons of Aaron shall sprinkle its blood
around on the altar.
14 He shall offer from it as his offering,
an offering made by fire to Yahweh; the
fat that covers the innards, and all the fat
that is on the innards,
15 and the two kidneys, and the fat that
is on them, which is by the loins, and the
cover on the liver, with the kidneys, he
shall take away.

† **2:13** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

16 The priest shall burn them on the
altar: it is the food of the offering made by
fire, for a pleasant aroma; all the fat is
Yahweh's.
17 " 'It shall be a perpetual statute
throughout your generations in all your
dwellings, that you shall eat neither fat
nor blood.' "

4

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, saying,
'If anyone sins unintentionally, in any of
the things which Yahweh has commanded
not to be done, and does any one of them,
3 if the anointed priest sins so as to bring
guilt on the people, then let him offer for
his sin which he has sinned a young bull
without defect to Yahweh for a sin
offering.
4 He shall bring the bull to the door of
the Tent of Meeting before Yahweh; and
he shall lay his hand on the head of the
bull, and kill the bull before Yahweh.
5 The anointed priest shall take some of
the blood of the bull, and bring it to the
Tent of Meeting.
6 The priest shall dip his finger in the
blood, and sprinkle some of the blood
seven times before Yahweh, before the
veil of the sanctuary.
7 The priest shall put some of the blood
on the horns of the altar of sweet incense
before Yahweh, which is in the Tent of
Meeting; and he shall pour out the rest of
the blood of the bull at the base of the
altar of burnt offering, which is at the
door of the Tent of Meeting.
8 He shall take all the fat of the bull of
the sin offering from it: the fat that covers
the innards, and all the fat that is on the
innards,
9 and the two kidneys, and the fat that is
on them, which is by the loins, and the
cover on the liver, with the kidneys, he
shall remove,
10 as it is removed from the bull of the
sacrifice of peace offerings. The priest
shall burn them on the altar of burnt
offering.
11 He shall carry the bull's skin, all its
meat, with its head, and with its legs, its
innards, and its dung
12 —all the rest of the bull—outside of the
camp to a clean place where the ashes are
poured out, and burn it on wood with fire.
It shall be burned where the ashes are
poured out.
13 " 'If the whole congregation of Israel
sins, and the thing is hidden from the eyes
of the assembly, and they have done any
of the things which Yahweh has
commanded not to be done, and are
guilty;
14 when the sin in which they have
sinned is known, then the assembly shall
offer a young bull for a sin offering, and
bring it before the Tent of Meeting.
15 The elders of the congregation shall
lay their hands on the head of the bull
before Yahweh; and the bull shall be
killed before Yahweh.
16 The anointed priest shall bring some
of the blood of the bull to the Tent of
Meeting.
17 The priest shall dip his finger in the
blood and sprinkle it seven times before
Yahweh, before the veil.
18 He shall put some of the blood on the
horns of the altar which is before Yahweh,
that is in the Tent of Meeting; and the rest
of the blood he shall pour out at the base
of the altar of burnt offering, which is at
the door of the Tent of Meeting.
19 All its fat he shall take from it, and
burn it on the altar.
20 He shall do this with the bull; as he
did with the bull of the sin offering, so he
shall do with this; and the priest shall
make atonement for them, and they shall
be forgiven.
21 He shall carry the bull outside the
camp, and burn it as he burned the first
bull. It is the sin offering for the assembly.
22 " 'When a ruler sins, and unwittingly
does any one of all the things which
Yahweh his God has commanded not to be
done, and is guilty,
23 if his sin in which he has sinned is
made known to him, he shall bring as his
offering a goat, a male without defect.

24 He shall lay his hand on the head of
the goat, and kill it in the place where they
kill the burnt offering before Yahweh. It is
a sin offering.
25 The priest shall take some of the
blood of the sin offering with his finger,
and put it on the horns of the altar of
burnt offering. He shall pour out the rest
of its blood at the base of the altar of burnt
offering.
26 All its fat he shall burn on the altar,
like the fat of the sacrifice of peace
offerings; and the priest shall make
atonement for him concerning his sin,
and he will be forgiven.

27 " 'If anyone of the common people
sins unwittingly, in doing any of the
things which Yahweh has commanded
not to be done, and is guilty,
28 if his sin which he has sinned is made
known to him, then he shall bring for his
offering a goat, a female without defect,
for his sin which he has sinned.
29 He shall lay his hand on the head of
the sin offering, and kill the sin offering in
the place of burnt offering.
30 The priest shall take some of its blood
with his finger, and put it on the horns of
the altar of burnt offering; and the rest of
its blood he shall pour out at the base of
the altar.
31 All its fat he shall take away, like the
fat is taken away from the sacrifice of
peace offerings; and the priest shall burn
it on the altar for a pleasant aroma to
Yahweh; and the priest shall make
atonement for him, and he will be
forgiven.

32 " 'If he brings a lamb as his offering
for a sin offering, he shall bring a female
without defect.
33 He shall lay his hand on the head of
the sin offering, and kill it for a sin
offering in the place where they kill the
burnt offering.
34 The priest shall take some of the
blood of the sin offering with his finger,
and put it on the horns of the altar of
burnt offering; and all the rest of its blood
he shall pour out at the base of the altar.
35 He shall remove all its fat, like the fat
of the lamb is removed from the sacrifice
of peace offerings. The priest shall burn
them on the altar, on the offerings of
Yahweh made by fire. The priest shall
make atonement for him concerning his
sin that he has sinned, and he will be
forgiven.

5

1 " 'If anyone sins, in that he hears a
public adjuration to testify, he being a
witness, whether he has seen or known, if
he doesn't report it, then he shall bear his
iniquity.
2 " 'Or if anyone touches any unclean
thing, whether it is the carcass of an
unclean animal, or the carcass of unclean
livestock, or the carcass of unclean
creeping things, and it is hidden from him,
and he is unclean, then he shall be guilty.
3 " 'Or if he touches the uncleanness of
man, whatever his uncleanness is with
which he is unclean, and it is hidden from
him; when he knows of it, then he shall be
guilty.
4 " 'Or if anyone swears rashly with his
lips to do evil or to do good—whatever it is
that a man might utter rashly with an
oath, and it is hidden from him—when he
knows of it, then he will be guilty of one of
these.
5 It shall be, when he is guilty of one of
these, he shall confess that in which he
has sinned;
6 and he shall bring his trespass offering
to Yahweh for his sin which he has
sinned: a female from the flock, a lamb or
a goat, for a sin offering; and the priest
shall make atonement for him concerning
his sin.
7 " 'If he can't afford a lamb, then he
shall bring his trespass offering for that in
which he has sinned, two turtledoves, or
two young pigeons, to Yahweh; one for a
sin offering, and the other for a burnt
offering.
8 He shall bring them to the priest, who
shall first offer the one which is for the sin
offering. He shall wring off its head from
its neck, but shall not sever it completely.

9 He shall sprinkle some of the blood of
the sin offering on the side of the altar;
and the rest of the blood shall be drained
out at the base of the altar. It is a sin
offering.
10 He shall offer the second for a burnt
offering, according to the ordinance; and
the priest shall make atonement for him
concerning his sin which he has sinned,
and he shall be forgiven.

11 " 'But if he can't afford two
turtledoves or two young pigeons, then he
shall bring as his offering for that in
which he has sinned, one tenth of an
ephah† of fine flour for a sin offering. He
shall put no oil on it, and he shall not put
any frankincense on it, for it is a sin
offering.
12 He shall bring it to the priest, and the
priest shall take his handful of it as the
memorial portion, and burn it on the
altar, on the offerings of Yahweh made by
fire. It is a sin offering.
13 The priest shall make atonement for
him concerning his sin that he has sinned
in any of these things, and he will be
forgiven; and the rest shall be the priest's,
as the meal offering.' "

14 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
15 "If anyone commits a trespass, and
sins unwittingly regarding Yahweh's holy
things, then he shall bring his trespass
offering to Yahweh: a ram without defect
from the flock, according to your
estimation in silver by shekels, according
to the shekel‡ of the sanctuary, for a
trespass offering.
16 He shall make restitution for that
which he has done wrong regarding the
holy thing, and shall add a fifth part to it,
and give it to the priest; and the priest
shall make atonement for him with the
ram of the trespass offering, and he will
be forgiven.

17 "If anyone sins, doing any of the
things which Yahweh has commanded not
to be done, though he didn't know it, he is
still guilty, and shall bear his iniquity.
18 He shall bring a ram without defect
from of the flock, according to your
estimation, for a trespass offering, to the
priest; and the priest shall make
atonement for him concerning the thing
in which he sinned and didn't know it,
and he will be forgiven.
19 It is a trespass offering. He is
certainly guilty before Yahweh."

6

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "If anyone sins, and commits a
trespass against Yahweh, and deals falsely
with his neighbor in a matter of deposit,
or of bargain, or of robbery, or has
oppressed his neighbor,
3 or has found that which was lost, and
lied about it, and swearing to a lie—in any
of these things that a man sins in his
actions—
4 then it shall be, if he has sinned, and is
guilty, he shall restore that which he took
by robbery, or the thing which he has
gotten by oppression, or the deposit
which was committed to him, or the lost
thing which he found,
5 or any thing about which he has sworn
falsely: he shall restore it in full, and shall
add a fifth part more to it. He shall return
it to him to whom it belongs in the day of
his being found guilty.
6 He shall bring his trespass offering to
Yahweh: a ram without defect from the
flock, according to your estimation, for a
trespass offering, to the priest.
7 The priest shall make atonement for
him before Yahweh, and he will be
forgiven concerning whatever he does to
become guilty."
8 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
9 "Command Aaron and his sons, saying,
'This is the law of the burnt offering: the
burnt offering shall be on the hearth on
the altar all night until the morning; and
the fire of the altar shall be kept burning
on it.
10 The priest shall put on his linen
garment, and he shall put on his linen

† **5:11** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

‡ **5:15** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

trousers upon his body; and he shall
remove the ashes from where the fire has
consumed the burnt offering on the altar,
and he shall put them beside the altar.
11 He shall take off his garments, and
put on other garments, and carry the
ashes outside the camp to a clean place.
12 The fire on the altar shall be kept
burning on it, it shall not go out; and the
priest shall burn wood on it every
morning. He shall lay the burnt offering
in order upon it, and shall burn on it the
fat of the peace offerings.
13 Fire shall be kept burning on the altar
continually; it shall not go out.

14 " 'This is the law of the meal offering:
the sons of Aaron shall offer it before
Yahweh, before the altar.
15 He shall take from there his handful
of the fine flour of the meal offering, and
of its oil, and all the frankincense which is
on the meal offering, and shall burn it on
the altar for a pleasant aroma, as its
memorial portion, to Yahweh.
16 That which is left of it Aaron and his
sons shall eat. It shall be eaten without
yeast in a holy place. They shall eat it in
the court of the Tent of Meeting.
17 It shall not be baked with yeast. I have
given it as their portion of my offerings
made by fire. It is most holy, as are the sin
offering and the trespass offering.
18 Every male among the children of
Aaron shall eat of it, as their portion
forever throughout your generations,
from the offerings of Yahweh made by
fire. Whoever touches them shall be
holy.' "

19 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
20 "This is the offering of Aaron and of
his sons, which they shall offer to Yahweh
in the day when he is anointed: one tenth
of an ephah† of fine flour for a meal
offering perpetually, half of it in the
morning, and half of it in the evening.
21 It shall be made with oil in a griddle.
When it is soaked, you shall bring it in.
You shall offer the meal offering in baked
pieces for a pleasant aroma to Yahweh.

† **6:20** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

22 The anointed priest that will be in his
place from among his sons shall offer it.
By a statute forever, it shall be wholly
burned to Yahweh.
23 Every meal offering of a priest shall
be wholly burned. It shall not be eaten."
24 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
25 "Speak to Aaron and to his sons,
saying, 'This is the law of the sin offering:
in the place where the burnt offering is
killed, the sin offering shall be killed
before Yahweh. It is most holy.
26 The priest who offers it for sin shall
eat it. It shall be eaten in a holy place, in
the court of the Tent of Meeting.
27 Whatever shall touch its flesh shall be
holy. When there is any of its blood
sprinkled on a garment, you shall wash
that on which it was sprinkled in a holy
place.
28 But the earthen vessel in which it is
boiled shall be broken; and if it is boiled in
a bronze vessel, it shall be scoured, and
rinsed in water.
29 Every male among the priests shall
eat of it. It is most holy.
30 No sin offering, of which any of the
blood is brought into the Tent of Meeting
to make atonement in the Holy Place,
shall be eaten. It shall be burned with fire.

7

1 " 'This is the law of the trespass
offering: It is most holy.
2 In the place where they kill the burnt
offering, he shall kill the trespass offering;
and its blood he shall sprinkle around on
the altar.
3 He shall offer all of its fat: the fat tail,
and the fat that covers the innards,
4 and he shall take away the two
kidneys, and the fat that is on them, which
is by the loins, and the cover on the liver,
with the kidneys;
5 and the priest shall burn them on the
altar for an offering made by fire to
Yahweh: it is a trespass offering.
6 Every male among the priests may eat
of it. It shall be eaten in a holy place. It is
most holy.

7 “ ‘As is the sin offering, so is the
trespass offering; there is one law for
them. The priest who makes atonement
with them shall have it.
8 The priest who offers any man’s burnt
offering shall have for himself the skin of
the burnt offering which he has offered.
9 Every meal offering that is baked in
the oven, and all that is prepared in the
pan and on the griddle, shall be the
priest’s who offers it.
10 Every meal offering, mixed with oil or
dry, belongs to all the sons of Aaron, one
as well as another.
11 “ ‘This is the law of the sacrifice of
peace offerings, which one shall offer to
Yahweh:
12 If he offers it for a thanksgiving, then
he shall offer with the sacrifice of
thanksgiving unleavened cakes mixed
with oil, and unleavened wafers anointed
with oil, and cakes mixed with oil.
13 He shall offer his offering with the
sacrifice of his peace offerings for
thanksgiving with cakes of leavened
bread.
14 Of it he shall offer one out of each
offering for a heave offering to Yahweh. It
shall be the priest’s who sprinkles the
blood of the peace offerings.
15 The flesh of the sacrifice of his peace
offerings for thanksgiving shall be eaten
on the day of his offering. He shall not
leave any of it until the morning.
16 “ ‘But if the sacrifice of his offering is
a vow, or a free will offering, it shall be
eaten on the day that he offers his
sacrifice. On the next day what remains of
it shall be eaten,
17 but what remains of the meat of the
sacrifice on the third day shall be burned
with fire.
18 If any of the meat of the sacrifice of
his peace offerings is eaten on the third
day, it will not be accepted, and it shall not
be credited to him who offers it. It will be
an abomination, and the soul who eats
any of it will bear his iniquity.
19 “ ‘The meat that touches any unclean
thing shall not be eaten. It shall be burned
with fire. As for the meat, everyone who is
clean may eat it;
20 but the soul who eats of the meat of
the sacrifice of peace offerings that
belongs to Yahweh, having his
uncleanness on him, that soul shall be cut
off from his people.
21 When anyone touches any unclean
thing, the uncleanness of man, or an
unclean animal, or any unclean
abomination, and eats some of the meat of
the sacrifice of peace offerings which
belong to Yahweh, that soul shall be cut
off from his people.’ ”

22 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
23 “Speak to the children of Israel,
saying, ‘You shall eat no fat, of bull, or
sheep, or goat.
24 The fat of that which dies of itself, and
the fat of that which is torn of animals,
may be used for any other service, but you
shall in no way eat of it.
25 For whoever eats the fat of the animal
which men offer as an offering made by
fire to Yahweh, even the soul who eats it
shall be cut off from his people.
26 You shall not eat any blood, whether
it is of bird or of animal, in any of your
dwellings.
27 Whoever it is who eats any blood, that
soul shall be cut off from his people.’ ”

28 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
29 “Speak to the children of Israel,
saying, ‘He who offers the sacrifice of his
peace offerings to Yahweh shall bring his
offering to Yahweh out of the sacrifice of
his peace offerings.
30 With his own hands he shall bring the
offerings of Yahweh made by fire. He
shall bring the fat with the breast, that the
breast may be waved for a wave offering
before Yahweh.
31 The priest shall burn the fat on the
altar, but the breast shall be Aaron’s and
his sons’.
32 The right thigh you shall give to the
priest for a heave offering out of the
sacrifices of your peace offerings.
33 He among the sons of Aaron who
offers the blood of the peace offerings,
and the fat, shall have the right thigh for a
portion.

34 For the waved breast and the heaved
thigh I have taken from the children of
Israel out of the sacrifices of their peace
offerings, and have given them to Aaron
the priest and to his sons as their portion
forever from the children of Israel.' "
35 This is the consecrated portion of
Aaron, and the consecrated portion of his
sons, out of the offerings of Yahweh made
by fire, in the day when he presented
them to minister to Yahweh in the priest's
office;
36 which Yahweh commanded to be
given them of the children of Israel, in the
day that he anointed them. It is their
portion forever throughout their
generations.
37 This is the law of the burnt offering,
the meal offering, the sin offering, the
trespass offering, the consecration, and
the sacrifice of peace offerings
38 which Yahweh commanded Moses in
Mount Sinai in the day that he
commanded the children of Israel to offer
their offerings to Yahweh, in the
wilderness of Sinai.

8

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Take Aaron and his sons with him,
and the garments, and the anointing oil,
and the bull of the sin offering, and the
two rams, and the basket of unleavened
bread;
3 and assemble all the congregation at
the door of the Tent of Meeting."
4 Moses did as Yahweh commanded
him; and the congregation was assembled
at the door of the Tent of Meeting.
5 Moses said to the congregation, "This
is the thing which Yahweh has
commanded to be done."
6 Moses brought Aaron and his sons,
and washed them with water.
7 He put the tunic on him, tied the sash
on him, clothed him with the robe, put the
ephod on him, and he tied the skillfully
woven band of the ephod on him and
fastened it to him with it.
8 He placed the breastplate on him. He
put the Urim and Thummim in the
breastplate.
9 He set the turban on his head. He set
the golden plate, the holy crown, on the
front of the turban, as Yahweh
commanded Moses.
10 Moses took the anointing oil, and
anointed the tabernacle and all that was
in it, and sanctified them.
11 He sprinkled it on the altar seven
times, and anointed the altar and all its
vessels, and the basin and its base, to
sanctify them.
12 He poured some of the anointing oil
on Aaron's head, and anointed him, to
sanctify him.
13 Moses brought Aaron's sons, and
clothed them with tunics, and tied sashes
on them, and put headbands on them, as
Yahweh commanded Moses.
14 He brought the bull of the sin offering,
and Aaron and his sons laid their hands
on the head of the bull of the sin offering.
15 He killed it; and Moses took the blood,
and put it around on the horns of the altar
with his finger, and purified the altar, and
poured out the blood at the base of the
altar, and sanctified it, to make atonement
for it.
16 He took all the fat that was on the
innards, and the cover of the liver, and
the two kidneys, and their fat; and Moses
burned it on the altar.
17 But the bull, and its skin, and its meat,
and its dung, he burned with fire outside
the camp, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
18 He presented the ram of the burnt
offering. Aaron and his sons laid their
hands on the head of the ram.
19 He killed it; and Moses sprinkled the
blood around on the altar.
20 He cut the ram into its pieces; and
Moses burned the head, and the pieces,
and the fat.
21 He washed the innards and the legs
with water; and Moses burned the whole
ram on the altar. It was a burnt offering
for a pleasant aroma. It was an offering
made by fire to Yahweh, as Yahweh
commanded Moses.
22 He presented the other ram, the ram
of consecration. Aaron and his sons laid
their hands on the head of the ram.
23 He killed it; and Moses took some of
its blood, and put it on the tip of Aaron's

right ear, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the great toe of his right foot.
24 He brought Aaron's sons; and Moses put some of the blood on the tip of their right ear, and on the thumb of their right hand, and on the great toe of their right foot; and Moses sprinkled the blood around on the altar.
25 He took the fat, the fat tail, all the fat that was on the innards, the cover of the liver, the two kidneys and their fat, and the right thigh;
26 and out of the basket of unleavened bread that was before Yahweh, he took one unleavened cake, one cake of oiled bread, and one wafer, and placed them on the fat and on the right thigh.
27 He put all these in Aaron's hands and in his sons' hands, and waved them for a wave offering before Yahweh.
28 Moses took them from their hands, and burned them on the altar on the burnt offering. They were a consecration offering for a pleasant aroma. It was an offering made by fire to Yahweh.
29 Moses took the breast, and waved it for a wave offering before Yahweh. It was Moses' portion of the ram of consecration, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
30 Moses took some of the anointing oil, and some of the blood which was on the altar, and sprinkled it on Aaron, on his garments, and on his sons, and on his sons' garments with him, and sanctified Aaron, his garments, and his sons, and his sons' garments with him.
31 Moses said to Aaron and to his sons, "Boil the meat at the door of the Tent of Meeting, and there eat it and the bread that is in the basket of consecration, as I commanded, saying, 'Aaron and his sons shall eat it.'
32 What remains of the meat and of the bread you shall burn with fire.
33 You shall not go out from the door of the Tent of Meeting for seven days, until the days of your consecration are fulfilled: for he shall consecrate you seven days.
34 What has been done today, so Yahweh has commanded to do, to make atonement for you.
35 You shall stay at the door of the Tent of Meeting day and night seven days, and keep Yahweh's command, that you don't die: for so I am commanded."
36 Aaron and his sons did all the things which Yahweh commanded by Moses.

9

1 On the eighth day, Moses called Aaron and his sons, and the elders of Israel;
2 and he said to Aaron, "Take a calf from the herd for a sin offering, and a ram for a burnt offering, without defect, and offer them before Yahweh.
3 You shall speak to the children of Israel, saying, 'Take a male goat for a sin offering; and a calf and a lamb, both a year old, without defect, for a burnt offering;
4 and a bull and a ram for peace offerings, to sacrifice before Yahweh; and a meal offering mixed with oil: for today Yahweh appears to you.' "
5 They brought what Moses commanded before the Tent of Meeting. All the congregation came near and stood before Yahweh.
6 Moses said, "This is the thing which Yahweh commanded that you should do; and Yahweh's glory shall appear to you."
7 Moses said to Aaron, "Draw near to the altar, and offer your sin offering, and your burnt offering, and make atonement for yourself, and for the people; and offer the offering of the people, and make atonement for them, as Yahweh commanded."
8 So Aaron came near to the altar, and killed the calf of the sin offering, which was for himself.
9 The sons of Aaron presented the blood to him; and he dipped his finger in the blood, and put it on the horns of the altar, and poured out the blood at the base of the altar;
10 but the fat, and the kidneys, and the cover from the liver of the sin offering, he burned upon the altar, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
11 The meat and the skin he burned with fire outside the camp.

12 He killed the burnt offering; and
Aaron's sons delivered the blood to him,
and he sprinkled it around on the altar.
13 They delivered the burnt offering to
him, piece by piece, and the head. He
burned them upon the altar.
14 He washed the innards and the legs,
and burned them on the burnt offering on
the altar.
15 He presented the people's offering,
and took the goat of the sin offering which
was for the people, and killed it, and
offered it for sin, like the first.
16 He presented the burnt offering, and
offered it according to the ordinance.
17 He presented the meal offering, and
filled his hand from there, and burned it
upon the altar, in addition to the burnt
offering of the morning.
18 He also killed the bull and the ram,
the sacrifice of peace offerings, which was
for the people. Aaron's sons delivered to
him the blood, which he sprinkled around
on the altar;
19 and the fat of the bull and of the ram,
the fat tail, and that which covers the
innards, and the kidneys, and the cover of
the liver;
20 and they put the fat upon the breasts,
and he burned the fat on the altar.
21 Aaron waved the breasts and the
right thigh for a wave offering before
Yahweh, as Moses commanded.
22 Aaron lifted up his hands toward the
people, and blessed them; and he came
down from offering the sin offering, and
the burnt offering, and the peace
offerings.
23 Moses and Aaron went into the Tent
of Meeting, and came out, and blessed the
people; and Yahweh's glory appeared to
all the people.
24 Fire came out from before Yahweh,
and consumed the burnt offering and the
fat upon the altar. When all the people
saw it, they shouted, and fell on their
faces.

10

1 Nadab and Abihu, the sons of Aaron,
each took his censer, and put fire in it, and
laid incense on it, and offered strange fire
before Yahweh, which he had not
commanded them.
2 Fire came out from before Yahweh,
and devoured them, and they died before
Yahweh.
3 Then Moses said to Aaron, "This is
what Yahweh spoke of, saying,
'I will show myself holy to those who
come near me,
and before all the people I will be
glorified.' "
Aaron held his peace.
4 Moses called Mishael and Elzaphan,
the sons of Uzziel the uncle of Aaron, and
said to them, "Draw near, carry your
brothers from before the sanctuary out of
the camp."
5 So they came near, and carried them
in their tunics out of the camp, as Moses
had said.
6 Moses said to Aaron, and to Eleazar
and to Ithamar, his sons, "Don't let the
hair of your heads go loose, and don't tear
your clothes, so that you don't die, and so
that he will not be angry with all the
congregation; but let your brothers, the
whole house of Israel, bewail the burning
which Yahweh has kindled.
7 You shall not go out from the door of
the Tent of Meeting, lest you die; for the
anointing oil of Yahweh is on you." They
did according to the word of Moses.
8 Then Yahweh said to Aaron,
9 "You and your sons are not to drink
wine or strong drink whenever you go
into the Tent of Meeting, or you will die.
This shall be a statute forever throughout
your generations.
10 You are to make a distinction between
the holy and the common, and between
the unclean and the clean.
11 You are to teach the children of Israel
all the statutes which Yahweh has spoken
to them by Moses."
12 Moses spoke to Aaron, and to Eleazar
and to Ithamar, his sons who were left,
"Take the meal offering that remains of
the offerings of Yahweh made by fire, and
eat it without yeast beside the altar; for it
is most holy;
13 and you shall eat it in a holy place,
because it is your portion, and your sons'

portion, of the offerings of Yahweh made by fire; for so I am commanded.
14 The waved breast and the heaved thigh you shall eat in a clean place, you, and your sons, and your daughters with you: for they are given as your portion, and your sons' portion, out of the sacrifices of the peace offerings of the children of Israel.
15 They shall bring the heaved thigh and the waved breast with the offerings made by fire of the fat, to wave it for a wave offering before Yahweh. It shall be yours, and your sons' with you, as a portion forever, as Yahweh has commanded."
16 Moses diligently inquired about the goat of the sin offering, and, behold,† it was burned. He was angry with Eleazar and with Ithamar, the sons of Aaron who were left, saying,
17 "Why haven't you eaten the sin offering in the place of the sanctuary, since it is most holy, and he has given it to you to bear the iniquity of the congregation, to make atonement for them before Yahweh?
18 Behold, its blood was not brought into the inner part of the sanctuary. You certainly should have eaten it in the sanctuary, as I commanded."
19 Aaron spoke to Moses, "Behold, today they have offered their sin offering and their burnt offering before Yahweh; and such things as these have happened to me. If I had eaten the sin offering today, would it have been pleasing in Yahweh's sight?"
20 When Moses heard that, it was pleasing in his sight.

11

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying to them,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, saying, 'These are the living things which you may eat among all the animals that are on the earth.
3 Whatever parts the hoof, and is cloven-footed, and chews the cud among the animals, that you may eat.
4 " 'Nevertheless these you shall not eat of those that chew the cud, or of those who part the hoof: the camel, because it chews the cud but doesn't have a parted hoof, is unclean to you.
5 The hyrax,† because it chews the cud but doesn't have a parted hoof, is unclean to you.
6 The hare, because it chews the cud but doesn't have a parted hoof, is unclean to you.
7 The pig, because it has a split hoof, and is cloven-footed, but doesn't chew the cud, is unclean to you.
8 You shall not eat their meat. You shall not touch their carcasses. They are unclean to you.
9 " 'You may eat of all these that are in the waters: whatever has fins and scales in the waters, in the seas, and in the rivers, that you may eat.
10 All that don't have fins and scales in the seas and rivers, all that move in the waters, and all the living creatures that are in the waters, they are an abomination to you,
11 and you shall detest them. You shall not eat of their meat, and you shall detest their carcasses.
12 Whatever has no fins nor scales in the waters is an abomination to you.
13 " 'You shall detest these among the birds; they shall not be eaten because they are an abomination: the eagle, the vulture, the black vulture,
14 the red kite, any kind of black kite,
15 any kind of raven,
16 the horned owl, the screech owl, the gull, any kind of hawk,
17 the little owl, the cormorant, the great owl,
18 the white owl, the desert owl, the osprey,
19 the stork, any kind of heron, the hoopoe, and the bat.
20 " 'All flying insects that walk on all fours are an abomination to you.
21 Yet you may eat these: of all winged creeping things that go on all fours, which

† **10:16** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
† **11:5** or rock badger, or cony

have long, jointed legs for hopping on the earth.
22 Even of these you may eat: any kind of locust, any kind of katydid, any kind of cricket, and any kind of grasshopper.
23 But all winged creeping things which have four feet are an abomination to you.
24 “ ‘By these you will become unclean: whoever touches their carcass shall be unclean until the evening.
25 Whoever carries any part of their carcass shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening.
26 “ ‘Every animal which has a split hoof that isn’t completely divided, or doesn’t chew the cud, is unclean to you. Everyone who touches them shall be unclean.
27 Whatever goes on its paws, among all animals that go on all fours, they are unclean to you. Whoever touches their carcass shall be unclean until the evening.
28 He who carries their carcass shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening. They are unclean to you.
29 “ ‘These are they which are unclean to you among the creeping things that creep on the earth: the weasel, the rat, any kind of great lizard,
30 the gecko, and the monitor lizard, the wall lizard, the skink, and the chameleon.
31 These are they which are unclean to you among all that creep. Whoever touches them when they are dead shall be unclean until the evening.
32 Anything they fall on when they are dead shall be unclean; whether it is any vessel of wood, or clothing, or skin, or sack, whatever vessel it is, with which any work is done, it must be put into water, and it shall be unclean until the evening. Then it will be clean.
33 Every earthen vessel into which any of them falls and all that is in it shall be unclean. You shall break it.
34 All food which may be eaten which is soaked in water shall be unclean. All drink that may be drunk in every such vessel shall be unclean.
35 Everything whereupon part of their carcass falls shall be unclean; whether oven, or range for pots, it shall be broken in pieces. They are unclean, and shall be unclean to you.
36 Nevertheless a spring or a cistern in which water is gathered shall be clean, but that which touches their carcass shall be unclean.
37 If part of their carcass falls on any sowing seed which is to be sown, it is clean.
38 But if water is put on the seed, and part of their carcass falls on it, it is unclean to you.
39 “ ‘If any animal of which you may eat dies, he who touches its carcass shall be unclean until the evening.
40 He who eats of its carcass shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening. He also who carries its carcass shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening.
41 “ ‘Every creeping thing that creeps on the earth is an abomination. It shall not be eaten.
42 Whatever goes on its belly, and whatever goes on all fours, or whatever has many feet, even all creeping things that creep on the earth, them you shall not eat; for they are an abomination.
43 You shall not make yourselves abominable with any creeping thing that creeps. You shall not make yourselves unclean with them, that you should be defiled by them.
44 For I am Yahweh your God. Sanctify yourselves therefore, and be holy; for I am holy. You shall not defile yourselves with any kind of creeping thing that moves on the earth.
45 For I am Yahweh who brought you up out of the land of Egypt, to be your God. You shall therefore be holy, for I am holy.
46 “ ‘This is the law of the animal, and of the bird, and of every living creature that moves in the waters, and of every creature that creeps on the earth,
47 to make a distinction between the unclean and the clean, and between the living thing that may be eaten and the living thing that may not be eaten.’ ”

12

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,

2 “Speak to the children of Israel, saying,
‘If a woman conceives, and bears a male
child, then she shall be unclean seven
days; as in the days of her monthly period
she shall be unclean.
3 In the eighth day the flesh of his
foreskin shall be circumcised.
4 She shall continue in the blood of
purification thirty-three days. She shall
not touch any holy thing, nor come into
the sanctuary, until the days of her
purifying are completed.
5 But if she bears a female child, then
she shall be unclean two weeks, as in her
period; and she shall continue in the
blood of purification sixty-six days.
6 “ ‘When the days of her purification
are completed for a son or for a daughter,
she shall bring to the priest at the door of
the Tent of Meeting, a year old lamb for a
burnt offering, and a young pigeon or a
turtledove, for a sin offering.
7 He shall offer it before Yahweh, and
make atonement for her; then she shall be
cleansed from the fountain of her blood.
“ ‘This is the law for her who bears,
whether a male or a female.
8 If she cannot afford a lamb, then she
shall take two turtledoves or two young
pigeons: the one for a burnt offering, and
the other for a sin offering. The priest
shall make atonement for her, and she
shall be clean.’ ”

13

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
saying,
2 “When a man shall have a swelling in
his body’s skin, or a scab, or a bright spot,
and it becomes in the skin of his body the
plague of leprosy, then he shall be
brought to Aaron the priest or to one of
his sons, the priests.
3 The priest shall examine the plague in
the skin of the body. If the hair in the
plague has turned white, and the
appearance of the plague is deeper than
the body’s skin, it is the plague of leprosy;
so the priest shall examine him and
pronounce him unclean.
4 If the bright spot is white in the skin of
his body, and its appearance isn’t deeper
than the skin, and its hair hasn’t turned
white, then the priest shall isolate the
infected person for seven days.
5 The priest shall examine him on the
seventh day. Behold, if in his eyes the
plague is arrested and the plague hasn’t
spread in the skin, then the priest shall
isolate him for seven more days.
6 The priest shall examine him again on
the seventh day. Behold, if the plague has
faded and the plague hasn’t spread in the
skin, then the priest shall pronounce him
clean. It is a scab. He shall wash his
clothes, and be clean.
7 But if the scab spreads on the skin
after he has shown himself to the priest
for his cleansing, he shall show himself to
the priest again.
8 The priest shall examine him; and
behold, if the scab has spread on the skin,
then the priest shall pronounce him
unclean. It is leprosy.
9 “When the plague of leprosy is in a
man, then he shall be brought to the
priest;
10 and the priest shall examine him.
Behold, if there is a white swelling in the
skin, and it has turned the hair white, and
there is raw flesh in the swelling,
11 it is a chronic leprosy in the skin of his
body, and the priest shall pronounce him
unclean. He shall not isolate him, for he is
already unclean.
12 “If the leprosy breaks out all over the
skin, and the leprosy covers all the skin of
the infected person from his head even to
his feet, as far as it appears to the priest,
13 then the priest shall examine him.
Behold, if the leprosy has covered all his
flesh, he shall pronounce him clean of the
plague. It has all turned white: he is clean.
14 But whenever raw flesh appears in
him, he shall be unclean.
15 The priest shall examine the raw
flesh, and pronounce him unclean: the
raw flesh is unclean. It is leprosy.
16 Or if the raw flesh turns again, and is
changed to white, then he shall come to
the priest.
17 The priest shall examine him. Behold,
if the plague has turned white, then the

priest shall pronounce him clean of the plague. He is clean.
18 “When the body has a boil on its skin, and it has healed,
19 and in the place of the boil there is a white swelling, or a bright spot, reddish-white, then it shall be shown to the priest.
20 The priest shall examine it. Behold, if its appearance is deeper than the skin, and its hair has turned white, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is the plague of leprosy. It has broken out in the boil.
21 But if the priest examines it, and behold, there are no white hairs in it, and it isn’t deeper than the skin, but is dim, then the priest shall isolate him seven days.
22 If it spreads in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is a plague.
23 But if the bright spot stays in its place, and hasn’t spread, it is the scar from the boil; and the priest shall pronounce him clean.
24 “Or when the body has a burn from fire on its skin, and the raw flesh of the burn becomes a bright spot, reddish-white, or white,
25 then the priest shall examine it; and behold, if the hair in the bright spot has turned white, and its appearance is deeper than the skin, it is leprosy. It has broken out in the burning, and the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is the plague of leprosy.
26 But if the priest examines it, and behold, there is no white hair in the bright spot, and it isn’t deeper than the skin, but has faded, then the priest shall isolate him seven days.
27 The priest shall examine him on the seventh day. If it has spread in the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is the plague of leprosy.
28 If the bright spot stays in its place, and hasn’t spread in the skin, but is faded, it is the swelling from the burn, and the priest shall pronounce him clean, for it is the scar from the burn.
29 “When a man or woman has a plague on the head or on the beard,
30 then the priest shall examine the plague; and behold, if its appearance is deeper than the skin, and the hair in it is yellow and thin, then the priest shall pronounce him unclean. It is an itch. It is leprosy of the head or of the beard.
31 If the priest examines the plague of itching, and behold, its appearance isn’t deeper than the skin, and there is no black hair in it, then the priest shall isolate the person infected with itching seven days.
32 On the seventh day the priest shall examine the plague; and behold, if the itch hasn’t spread, and there is no yellow hair in it, and the appearance of the itch isn’t deeper than the skin,
33 then he shall be shaved, but he shall not shave the itch. Then the priest shall isolate the one who has the itch seven more days.
34 On the seventh day, the priest shall examine the itch; and behold, if the itch hasn’t spread in the skin, and its appearance isn’t deeper than the skin, then the priest shall pronounce him clean. He shall wash his clothes and be clean.
35 But if the itch spreads in the skin after his cleansing,
36 then the priest shall examine him; and behold, if the itch has spread in the skin, the priest shall not look for the yellow hair; he is unclean.
37 But if in his eyes the itch is arrested and black hair has grown in it, then the itch is healed. He is clean. The priest shall pronounce him clean.
38 “When a man or a woman has bright spots in the skin of the body, even white bright spots,
39 then the priest shall examine them. Behold, if the bright spots on the skin of their body are a dull white, it is a harmless rash. It has broken out in the skin. He is clean.
40 “If a man’s hair has fallen from his head, he is bald. He is clean.
41 If his hair has fallen off from the front part of his head, his forehead is bald. He is clean.

42 But if a reddish-white plague is in the
bald head or the bald forehead, it is
leprosy breaking out in his bald head or
his bald forehead.
43 Then the priest shall examine him.
Behold, if the swelling of the plague is
reddish-white in his bald head, or in his
bald forehead, like the appearance of
leprosy in the skin of the body,
44 he is a leprous man. He is unclean.
The priest shall surely pronounce him
unclean. His plague is on his head.

45 "The leper in whom the plague is shall
wear torn clothes, and the hair of his head
shall hang loose. He shall cover his upper
lip, and shall cry, 'Unclean! Unclean!'
46 All the days in which the plague is in
him he shall be unclean. He is unclean.
He shall dwell alone. His dwelling shall be
outside of the camp.

47 "The garment also that the plague of
leprosy is in, whether it is a woolen
garment, or a linen garment;
48 whether it is in warp or woof;† of
linen or of wool; whether in leather, or in
anything made of leather;
49 if the plague is greenish or reddish in
the garment, or in the leather, or in the
warp, or in the woof, or in anything made
of leather; it is the plague of leprosy, and
shall be shown to the priest.
50 The priest shall examine the plague,
and isolate the plague seven days.
51 He shall examine the plague on the
seventh day. If the plague has spread in
the garment, either in the warp, or in the
woof, or in the skin, whatever use the skin
is used for, the plague is a destructive
mildew. It is unclean.
52 He shall burn the garment, whether
the warp or the woof, in wool or in linen,
or anything of leather, in which the
plague is, for it is a destructive mildew. It
shall be burned in the fire.

53 "If the priest examines it, and behold,
the plague hasn't spread in the garment,
either in the warp, or in the woof, or in
anything of skin;
54 then the priest shall command that
they wash the thing that the plague is in,
and he shall isolate it seven more days.
55 Then the priest shall examine it, after
the plague is washed; and behold, if the
plague hasn't changed its color, and the
plague hasn't spread, it is unclean; you
shall burn it in the fire. It is a mildewed
spot, whether the bareness is inside or
outside.
56 If the priest looks, and behold, the
plague has faded after it is washed, then
he shall tear it out of the garment, or out
of the skin, or out of the warp, or out of
the woof;
57 and if it appears again in the garment,
either in the warp, or in the woof, or in
anything of skin, it is spreading. You shall
burn what the plague is in with fire.
58 The garment, either the warp, or the
woof, or whatever thing of skin it is, which
you shall wash, if the plague has departed
from them, then it shall be washed the
second time, and it will be clean."
59 This is the law of the plague of
mildew in a garment of wool or linen,
either in the warp, or the woof, or in
anything of skin, to pronounce it clean, or
to pronounce it unclean.

14

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "This shall be the law of the leper in
the day of his cleansing: He shall be
brought to the priest,
3 and the priest shall go out of the camp.
The priest shall examine him. Behold, if
the plague of leprosy is healed in the
leper,
4 then the priest shall command them to
take for him who is to be cleansed two
living clean birds, cedar wood, scarlet,
and hyssop.
5 The priest shall command them to kill
one of the birds in an earthen vessel over
running water.
6 As for the living bird, he shall take it,
the cedar wood, the scarlet, and the
hyssop, and shall dip them and the living

† **13:48** warp and woof are the vertical and horizontal threads in woven cloth

bird in the blood of the bird that was killed over the running water.
7 He shall sprinkle on him who is to be cleansed from the leprosy seven times, and shall pronounce him clean, and shall let the living bird go into the open field.
8 "He who is to be cleansed shall wash his clothes, and shave off all his hair, and bathe himself in water; and he shall be clean. After that he shall come into the camp, but shall dwell outside his tent seven days.
9 It shall be on the seventh day, that he shall shave all his hair off his head and his beard and his eyebrows. He shall shave off all his hair. He shall wash his clothes, and he shall bathe his body in water. Then he shall be clean.
10 "On the eighth day he shall take two male lambs without defect, one ewe lamb a year old without defect, three tenths of an ephah† of fine flour for a meal offering, mixed with oil, and one log‡ of oil.
11 The priest who cleanses him shall set the man who is to be cleansed, and those things, before Yahweh, at the door of the Tent of Meeting.
12 "The priest shall take one of the male lambs, and offer him for a trespass offering, with the log of oil, and wave them for a wave offering before Yahweh.
13 He shall kill the male lamb in the place where they kill the sin offering and the burnt offering, in the place of the sanctuary; for as the sin offering is the priest's, so is the trespass offering. It is most holy.
14 The priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering, and the priest shall put it on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot.
15 The priest shall take some of the log of oil, and pour it into the palm of his own left hand.
16 The priest shall dip his right finger in the oil that is in his left hand, and shall sprinkle some of the oil with his finger seven times before Yahweh.
17 The priest shall put some of the rest of the oil that is in his hand on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot, upon the blood of the trespass offering.
18 The rest of the oil that is in the priest's hand he shall put on the head of him who is to be cleansed, and the priest shall make atonement for him before Yahweh.
19 "The priest shall offer the sin offering, and make atonement for him who is to be cleansed because of his uncleanness. Afterward he shall kill the burnt offering;
20 then the priest shall offer the burnt offering and the meal offering on the altar. The priest shall make atonement for him, and he shall be clean.
21 "If he is poor, and can't afford so much, then he shall take one male lamb for a trespass offering to be waved, to make atonement for him, and one tenth of an ephah§ of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering, and a log† of oil;
22 and two turtledoves, or two young pigeons, such as he is able to afford; and the one shall be a sin offering, and the other a burnt offering.
23 "On the eighth day he shall bring them for his cleansing to the priest, to the door of the Tent of Meeting, before Yahweh.
24 The priest shall take the lamb of the trespass offering, and the log of oil, and the priest shall wave them for a wave offering before Yahweh.
25 He shall kill the lamb of the trespass offering. The priest shall take some of the blood of the trespass offering and put it on the tip of the right ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on the thumb of his right hand, and on the big toe of his right foot.
26 The priest shall pour some of the oil into the palm of his own left hand;
27 and the priest shall sprinkle with his right finger some of the oil that is in his

† **14:10** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel ‡ **14:10** a log is a liquid measure of about 300 ml or 10 ounces § **14:21** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel † **14:21** a log is a liquid measure of about 300 ml or 10 ounces

left hand seven times before Yahweh.
28 Then the priest shall put some of the
oil that is in his hand on the tip of the right
ear of him who is to be cleansed, and on
the thumb of his right hand, and on the
big toe of his right foot, on the place of the
blood of the trespass offering.
29 The rest of the oil that is in the priest's
hand he shall put on the head of him who
is to be cleansed, to make atonement for
him before Yahweh.
30 He shall offer one of the turtledoves,
or of the young pigeons, which ever he is
able to afford,
31 of the kind he is able to afford, the
one for a sin offering, and the other for a
burnt offering, with the meal offering.
The priest shall make atonement for him
who is to be cleansed before Yahweh."
32 This is the law for him in whom is the
plague of leprosy, who is not able to
afford the sacrifice for his cleansing.
33 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
saying,
34 "When you have come into the land
of Canaan, which I give to you for a
possession, and I put a spreading mildew
in a house in the land of your possession,
35 then he who owns the house shall
come and tell the priest, saying, 'There
seems to me to be some sort of plague in
the house.'
36 The priest shall command that they
empty the house, before the priest goes in
to examine the plague, that all that is in
the house not be made unclean.
Afterward the priest shall go in to inspect
the house.
37 He shall examine the plague; and
behold, if the plague is in the walls of the
house with hollow streaks, greenish or
reddish, and it appears to be deeper than
the wall,
38 then the priest shall go out of the
house to the door of the house, and shut
up the house seven days.
39 The priest shall come again on the
seventh day, and look. If the plague has
spread in the walls of the house,
40 then the priest shall command that
they take out the stones in which is the
plague, and cast them into an unclean
place outside of the city.
41 He shall cause the inside of the house
to be scraped all over. They shall pour out
the mortar that they scraped off outside of
the city into an unclean place.
42 They shall take other stones, and put
them in the place of those stones; and he
shall take other mortar, and shall plaster
the house.
43 "If the plague comes again, and
breaks out in the house after he has taken
out the stones, and after he has scraped
the house, and after it was plastered,
44 then the priest shall come in and look;
and behold, if the plague has spread in the
house, it is a destructive mildew in the
house. It is unclean.
45 He shall break down the house, its
stones, and its timber, and all the house's
mortar. He shall carry them out of the city
into an unclean place.
46 "Moreover he who goes into the
house while it is shut up shall be unclean
until the evening.
47 He who lies down in the house shall
wash his clothes; and he who eats in the
house shall wash his clothes.
48 "If the priest shall come in, and
examine it, and behold, the plague hasn't
spread in the house, after the house was
plastered, then the priest shall pronounce
the house clean, because the plague is
healed.
49 To cleanse the house he shall take two
birds, cedar wood, scarlet, and hyssop.
50 He shall kill one of the birds in an
earthen vessel over running water.
51 He shall take the cedar wood, the
hyssop, the scarlet, and the living bird,
and dip them in the blood of the slain
bird, and in the running water, and
sprinkle the house seven times.
52 He shall cleanse the house with the
blood of the bird, and with the running
water, with the living bird, with the cedar
wood, with the hyssop, and with the
scarlet;
53 but he shall let the living bird go out
of the city into the open field. So shall he
make atonement for the house; and it
shall be clean."

54 This is the law for any plague of
leprosy, and for an itch,
55 and for the destructive mildew of a
garment, and for a house,
56 and for a swelling, and for a scab, and
for a bright spot;
57 to teach when it is unclean, and when
it is clean.
This is the law of leprosy.

15

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them, 'When any man has a discharge
from his body, because of his discharge he
is unclean.
3 This shall be his uncleanness in his
discharge: whether his body runs with his
discharge, or his body has stopped from
his discharge, it is his uncleanness.
4 " 'Every bed on which he who has the
discharge lies shall be unclean; and
everything he sits on shall be unclean.
5 Whoever touches his bed shall wash
his clothes, and bathe himself in water,
and be unclean until the evening.
6 He who sits on anything on which the
man who has the discharge sat shall wash
his clothes, and bathe himself in water,
and be unclean until the evening.
7 " 'He who touches the body of him who
has the discharge shall wash his clothes,
and bathe himself in water, and be
unclean until the evening.
8 " 'If he who has the discharge spits on
him who is clean, then he shall wash his
clothes, and bathe himself in water, and
be unclean until the evening.
9 " 'Whatever saddle he who has the
discharge rides on shall be unclean.
10 Whoever touches anything that was
under him shall be unclean until the
evening. He who carries those things shall
wash his clothes, and bathe himself in
water, and be unclean until the evening.
11 " 'Whomever he who has the
discharge touches, without having rinsed
his hands in water, he shall wash his
clothes, and bathe himself in water, and
be unclean until the evening.
12 " 'The earthen vessel, which he who
has the discharge touches, shall be
broken; and every vessel of wood shall be
rinsed in water.
13 " 'When he who has a discharge is
cleansed of his discharge, then he shall
count to himself seven days for his
cleansing, and wash his clothes; and he
shall bathe his flesh in running water, and
shall be clean.
14 " 'On the eighth day he shall take two
turtledoves, or two young pigeons, and
come before Yahweh to the door of the
Tent of Meeting, and give them to the
priest.
15 The priest shall offer them, the one
for a sin offering, and the other for a burnt
offering. The priest shall make atonement
for him before Yahweh for his discharge.
16 " 'If any man has an emission of
semen, then he shall bathe all his flesh in
water, and be unclean until the evening.
17 Every garment and every skin which
the semen is on shall be washed with
water, and be unclean until the evening.
18 If a man lies with a woman and there
is an emission of semen, they shall both
bathe themselves in water, and be
unclean until the evening.
19 " 'If a woman has a discharge, and her
discharge in her flesh is blood, she shall
be in her impurity seven days. Whoever
touches her shall be unclean until the
evening.
20 " 'Everything that she lies on in her
impurity shall be unclean. Everything
also that she sits on shall be unclean.
21 Whoever touches her bed shall wash
his clothes, and bathe himself in water,
and be unclean until the evening.
22 Whoever touches anything that she
sits on shall wash his clothes, and bathe
himself in water, and be unclean until the
evening.
23 If it is on the bed, or on anything she
sits on, when he touches it, he shall be
unclean until the evening.
24 " 'If any man lies with her, and her
monthly flow is on him, he shall be
unclean seven days; and every bed he lies
on shall be unclean.

25 “ ‘If a woman has a discharge of her
blood many days not in the time of her
period, or if she has a discharge beyond
the time of her period, all the days of the
discharge of her uncleanness shall be as
in the days of her period. She is unclean.
26 Every bed she lies on all the days of
her discharge shall be to her as the bed of
her period. Everything she sits on shall be
unclean, as the uncleanness of her period.
27 Whoever touches these things shall
be unclean, and shall wash his clothes and
bathe himself in water, and be unclean
until the evening.
28 “ ‘But if she is cleansed of her
discharge, then she shall count to herself
seven days, and after that she shall be
clean.
29 On the eighth day she shall take two
turtledoves, or two young pigeons, and
bring them to the priest, to the door of the
Tent of Meeting.
30 The priest shall offer the one for a sin
offering, and the other for a burnt
offering; and the priest shall make
atonement for her before Yahweh for the
uncleanness of her discharge.
31 “ ‘Thus you shall separate the
children of Israel from their uncleanness,
so they will not die in their uncleanness
when they defile my tabernacle that is
among them.’ ”
32 This is the law of him who has a
discharge, and of him who has an
emission of semen, so that he is unclean
by it;
33 and of her who has her period, and of
a man or woman who has a discharge,
and of him who lies with her who is
unclean.

16

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses after the death
of the two sons of Aaron, when they came
near before Yahweh, and died;
2 and Yahweh said to Moses, “Tell Aaron
your brother not to come at just any time
into the Most Holy Place within the veil,
before the mercy seat which is on the ark;
lest he die; for I will appear in the cloud
on the mercy seat.
3 “Aaron shall come into the sanctuary
with a young bull for a sin offering, and a
ram for a burnt offering.
4 He shall put on the holy linen tunic. He
shall have the linen trousers on his body,
and shall put on the linen sash, and he
shall be clothed with the linen turban.
They are the holy garments. He shall
bathe his body in water, and put them on.
5 He shall take from the congregation of
the children of Israel two male goats for a
sin offering, and one ram for a burnt
offering.
6 “Aaron shall offer the bull of the sin
offering, which is for himself, and make
atonement for himself and for his house.
7 He shall take the two goats, and set
them before Yahweh at the door of the
Tent of Meeting.
8 Aaron shall cast lots for the two goats:
one lot for Yahweh, and the other lot for
the scapegoat.
9 Aaron shall present the goat on which
the lot fell for Yahweh, and offer him for a
sin offering.
10 But the goat on which the lot fell for
the scapegoat shall be presented alive
before Yahweh, to make atonement for
him, to send him away as the scapegoat
into the wilderness.
11 “Aaron shall present the bull of the
sin offering, which is for himself, and
shall make atonement for himself and for
his house, and shall kill the bull of the sin
offering which is for himself.
12 He shall take a censer full of coals of
fire from off the altar before Yahweh, and
two handfuls of sweet incense beaten
small, and bring it within the veil.
13 He shall put the incense on the fire
before Yahweh, that the cloud of the
incense may cover the mercy seat that is
on the covenant, so that he will not die.
14 He shall take some of the blood of the
bull, and sprinkle it with his finger on the
mercy seat on the east; and before the
mercy seat he shall sprinkle some of the
blood with his finger seven times.
15 “Then he shall kill the goat of the sin
offering that is for the people, and bring
his blood within the veil, and do with his
blood as he did with the blood of the bull,

and sprinkle it on the mercy seat and before the mercy seat.
16 He shall make atonement for the Holy Place, because of the uncleanness of the children of Israel, and because of their transgressions, even all their sins; and so he shall do for the Tent of Meeting that dwells with them in the middle of their uncleanness.
17 No one shall be in the Tent of Meeting when he enters to make atonement in the Holy Place, until he comes out, and has made atonement for himself and for his household, and for all the assembly of Israel.
18 "He shall go out to the altar that is before Yahweh and make atonement for it, and shall take some of the bull's blood, and some of the goat's blood, and put it around on the horns of the altar.
19 He shall sprinkle some of the blood on it with his finger seven times, and cleanse it, and make it holy from the uncleanness of the children of Israel.
20 "When he has finished atoning for the Holy Place, the Tent of Meeting, and the altar, he shall present the live goat.
21 Aaron shall lay both his hands on the head of the live goat, and confess over him all the iniquities of the children of Israel, and all their transgressions, even all their sins; and he shall put them on the head of the goat, and shall send him away into the wilderness by the hand of a man who is ready.
22 The goat shall carry all their iniquities on himself to a solitary land, and he shall release the goat in the wilderness.
23 "Aaron shall come into the Tent of Meeting, and shall take off the linen garments which he put on when he went into the Holy Place, and shall leave them there.
24 Then he shall bathe himself in water in a holy place, put on his garments, and come out and offer his burnt offering and the burnt offering of the people, and make atonement for himself and for the people.
25 The fat of the sin offering he shall burn on the altar.
26 "He who lets the goat go as the scapegoat shall wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp.
27 The bull for the sin offering, and the goat for the sin offering, whose blood was brought in to make atonement in the Holy Place, shall be carried outside the camp; and they shall burn their skins, their flesh, and their dung with fire.
28 He who burns them shall wash his clothes, and bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp.
29 "It shall be a statute to you forever: in the seventh month, on the tenth day of the month, you shall afflict your souls, and shall do no kind of work, whether native-born or a stranger who lives as a foreigner among you;
30 for on this day shall atonement be made for you, to cleanse you. You shall be clean from all your sins before Yahweh.
31 It is a Sabbath of solemn rest to you, and you shall afflict your souls. It is a statute forever.
32 The priest, who is anointed and who is consecrated to be priest in his father's place, shall make the atonement, and shall put on the linen garments, even the holy garments.
33 Then he shall make atonement for the Holy Sanctuary; and he shall make atonement for the Tent of Meeting and for the altar; and he shall make atonement for the priests and for all the people of the assembly.
34 "This shall be an everlasting statute for you, to make atonement for the children of Israel once in the year because of all their sins."
It was done as Yahweh commanded Moses.

17

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Speak to Aaron, and to his sons, and to all the children of Israel, and say to them, 'This is the thing which Yahweh has commanded:
3 Whatever man there is of the house of Israel who kills a bull, or lamb, or goat in the camp, or who kills it outside the camp,
4 and hasn't brought it to the door of the Tent of Meeting to offer it as an offering to

Yahweh before Yahweh's tabernacle:
blood shall be imputed to that man. He
has shed blood. That man shall be cut off
from among his people.
5 This is to the end that the children of
Israel may bring their sacrifices, which
they sacrifice in the open field, that they
may bring them to Yahweh, to the door of
the Tent of Meeting, to the priest, and
sacrifice them for sacrifices of peace
offerings to Yahweh.
6 The priest shall sprinkle the blood on
Yahweh's altar at the door of the Tent of
Meeting, and burn the fat for a pleasant
aroma to Yahweh.
7 They shall no more sacrifice their
sacrifices to the goat idols, after which
they play the prostitute. This shall be a
statute forever to them throughout their
generations.'
8 "You shall say to them, 'Any man there
is of the house of Israel, or of the strangers
who live as foreigners among them, who
offers a burnt offering or sacrifice,
9 and doesn't bring it to the door of the
Tent of Meeting to sacrifice it to Yahweh,
that man shall be cut off from his people.
10 " 'Any man of the house of Israel, or of
the strangers who live as foreigners
among them, who eats any kind of blood, I
will set my face against that soul who eats
blood, and will cut him off from among
his people.
11 For the life of the flesh is in the blood.
I have given it to you on the altar to make
atonement for your souls; for it is the
blood that makes atonement by reason of
the life.
12 Therefore I have said to the children
of Israel, "No person among you may eat
blood, nor may any stranger who lives as
a foreigner among you eat blood."
13 " 'Whatever man there is of the
children of Israel, or of the strangers who
live as foreigners among them, who takes
in hunting any animal or bird that may be
eaten, he shall pour out its blood, and
cover it with dust.
14 For as to the life of all flesh, its blood
is with its life. Therefore I said to the
children of Israel, "You shall not eat the
blood of any kind of flesh; for the life of all
flesh is its blood. Whoever eats it shall be
cut off."
15 " 'Every person that eats what dies of
itself, or that which is torn by animals,
whether he is native-born or a foreigner,
shall wash his clothes, and bathe himself
in water, and be unclean until the
evening. Then he shall be clean.
16 But if he doesn't wash them, or bathe
his flesh, then he shall bear his iniquity.' "

18

1 Yahweh said to Moses,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
say to them, 'I am Yahweh your God.
3 You shall not do as they do in the land
of Egypt, where you lived. You shall not do
as they do in the land of Canaan, where I
am bringing you. You shall not follow
their statutes.
4 You shall do my ordinances. You shall
keep my statutes and walk in them. I am
Yahweh your God.
5 You shall therefore keep my statutes
and my ordinances, which if a man does,
he shall live in them. I am Yahweh.
6 " 'None of you shall approach any
close relatives, to uncover their
nakedness: I am Yahweh.
7 " 'You shall not uncover the nakedness
of your father, nor the nakedness of your
mother: she is your mother. You shall not
uncover her nakedness.
8 " 'You shall not uncover the nakedness
of your father's wife. It is your father's
nakedness.
9 " 'You shall not uncover the nakedness
of your sister, the daughter of your father,
or the daughter of your mother, whether
born at home or born abroad.
10 " 'You shall not uncover the
nakedness of your son's daughter, or of
your daughter's daughter, even their
nakedness; for theirs is your own
nakedness.
11 " 'You shall not uncover the
nakedness of your father's wife's
daughter, conceived by your father, since
she is your sister.
12 " 'You shall not uncover the
nakedness of your father's sister. She is
your father's near kinswoman.

13 “ ‘You shall not uncover the
nakedness of your mother’s sister, for she
is your mother’s near kinswoman.
14 “ ‘You shall not uncover the
nakedness of your father’s brother. You
shall not approach his wife. She is your
aunt.
15 “ ‘You shall not uncover the
nakedness of your daughter-in-law. She is
your son’s wife. You shall not uncover her
nakedness.
16 “ ‘You shall not uncover the
nakedness of your brother’s wife. It is
your brother’s nakedness.
17 “ ‘You shall not uncover the
nakedness of a woman and her daughter.
You shall not take her son’s daughter, or
her daughter’s daughter, to uncover her
nakedness. They are near kinswomen. It
is wickedness.
18 “ ‘You shall not take a wife in addition
to her sister, to be a rival, to uncover her
nakedness, while her sister is still alive.
19 “ ‘You shall not approach a woman to
uncover her nakedness, as long as she is
impure by her uncleanness.
20 “ ‘You shall not lie carnally with your
neighbor’s wife, and defile yourself with
her.
21 “ ‘You shall not give any of your
children as a sacrifice to Molech. You shall
not profane the name of your God. I am
Yahweh.
22 “ ‘You shall not lie with a man as with
a woman. That is detestable.
23 “ ‘You shall not lie with any animal to
defile yourself with it. No woman may
give herself to an animal, to lie down with
it: it is a perversion.
24 “ ‘Don’t defile yourselves in any of
these things; for in all these the nations
which I am casting out before you were
defiled.
25 The land was defiled. Therefore I
punished its iniquity, and the land
vomited out her inhabitants.
26 You therefore shall keep my statutes
and my ordinances, and shall not do any
of these abominations; neither the
native-born, nor the stranger who lives as
a foreigner among you
27 (for the men of the land that were
before you had done all these
abominations, and the land became
defiled),
28 that the land not vomit you out also,
when you defile it, as it vomited out the
nation that was before you.
29 “ ‘For whoever shall do any of these
abominations, even the souls that do them
shall be cut off from among their people.
30 Therefore you shall keep my
requirements, that you do not practice
any of these abominable customs which
were practiced before you, and that you
do not defile yourselves with them. I am
Yahweh your God.’ ”

19

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 “Speak to all the congregation of the
children of Israel, and tell them, ‘You shall
be holy; for I, Yahweh your God, am holy.
3 “ ‘Each one of you shall respect his
mother and his father. You shall keep my
Sabbaths. I am Yahweh your God.
4 “ ‘Don’t turn to idols, nor make molten
gods for yourselves. I am Yahweh your
God.
5 “ ‘When you offer a sacrifice of peace
offerings to Yahweh, you shall offer it so
that you may be accepted.
6 It shall be eaten the same day you offer
it, and on the next day. If anything
remains until the third day, it shall be
burned with fire.
7 If it is eaten at all on the third day, it is
an abomination. It will not be accepted;
8 but everyone who eats it shall bear his
iniquity, because he has profaned the
holy thing of Yahweh, and that soul shall
be cut off from his people.
9 “ ‘When you reap the harvest of your
land, you shall not wholly reap the
corners of your field, neither shall you
gather the gleanings of your harvest.
10 You shall not glean your vineyard,
neither shall you gather the fallen grapes
of your vineyard. You shall leave them for
the poor and for the foreigner. I am
Yahweh your God.
11 “ ‘You shall not steal.
“ ‘You shall not lie.
“ ‘You shall not deceive one another.

12 “ ‘You shall not swear by my name
falsely, and profane the name of your
God. I am Yahweh.
13 “ ‘You shall not oppress your
neighbor, nor rob him.
“ ‘The wages of a hired servant shall not
remain with you all night until the
morning.
14 “ ‘You shall not curse the deaf, nor put
a stumbling block before the blind; but
you shall fear your God. I am Yahweh.
15 “ ‘You shall do no injustice in
judgment. You shall not be partial to the
poor, nor show favoritism to the great;
but you shall judge your neighbor in
righteousness.
16 “ ‘You shall not go around as a
slanderer among your people.
“ ‘You shall not endanger the life† of
your neighbor. I am Yahweh.
17 “ ‘You shall not hate your brother in
your heart. You shall surely rebuke your
neighbor, and not bear sin because of him.
18 “ ‘You shall not take vengeance, nor
bear any grudge against the children of
your people; but you shall love your
neighbor as yourself. I am Yahweh.
19 “ ‘You shall keep my statutes.
“ ‘You shall not cross-breed different
kinds of animals.
“ ‘You shall not sow your field with two
kinds of seed;
“ ‘Don’t wear a garment made of two
kinds of material.
20 “ ‘If a man lies carnally with a woman
who is a slave girl, pledged to be married
to another man, and not ransomed or
given her freedom; they shall be
punished. They shall not be put to death,
because she was not free.
21 He shall bring his trespass offering to
Yahweh, to the door of the Tent of
Meeting, even a ram for a trespass
offering.
22 The priest shall make atonement for
him with the ram of the trespass offering
before Yahweh for his sin which he has
committed; and the sin which he has
committed shall be forgiven him.
23 “ ‘When you come into the land, and
have planted all kinds of trees for food,
then you shall count their fruit as
forbidden.‡ For three years it shall be
forbidden to you. It shall not be eaten.
24 But in the fourth year all its fruit shall
be holy, for giving praise to Yahweh.
25 In the fifth year you shall eat its fruit,
that it may yield its increase to you. I am
Yahweh your God.
26 “ ‘You shall not eat any meat with the
blood still in it. You shall not use
enchantments, nor practice sorcery.
27 “ ‘You shall not cut the hair on the
sides of your head or clip off the edge of
your beard.
28 “ ‘You shall not make any cuttings in
your flesh for the dead, nor tattoo any
marks on you. I am Yahweh.
29 “ ‘Don’t profane your daughter, to
make her a prostitute; lest the land fall to
prostitution, and the land become full of
wickedness.
30 “ ‘You shall keep my Sabbaths, and
reverence my sanctuary; I am Yahweh.
31 “ ‘Don’t turn to those who are
mediums, nor to the wizards. Don’t seek
them out, to be defiled by them. I am
Yahweh your God.
32 “ ‘You shall rise up before the gray
head and honor the face of the elderly;
and you shall fear your God. I am Yahweh.
33 “ ‘If a stranger lives as a foreigner
with you in your land, you shall not do
him wrong.
34 The stranger who lives as a foreigner
with you shall be to you as the native-born
among you, and you shall love him as
yourself; for you lived as foreigners in the
land of Egypt. I am Yahweh your God.
35 “ ‘You shall do no unrighteousness in
judgment, in measures of length, of
weight, or of quantity.
36 You shall have just balances, just
weights, a just ephah,§ and a just hin.† I
am Yahweh your God, who brought you
out of the land of Egypt.

† **19:16** literally, “blood” ‡ **19:23** literally, “uncircumcised” § **19:36** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel † **19:36** A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

37 “ ‘You shall observe all my statutes
and all my ordinances, and do them. I am
Yahweh.’ ”

20

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 “Moreover, you shall tell the children
of Israel, ‘Anyone of the children of Israel,
or of the strangers who live as foreigners
in Israel, who gives any of his offspring† to
Molech shall surely be put to death. The
people of the land shall stone that person
with stones.
3 I also will set my face against that
person, and will cut him off from among
his people, because he has given of his
offspring to Molech, to defile my
sanctuary, and to profane my holy name.
4 If the people of the land all hide their
eyes from that person when he gives of
his offspring to Molech, and don’t put him
to death,
5 then I will set my face against that man
and against his family, and will cut him
off, and all who play the prostitute after
him to play the prostitute with Molech,
from among their people.
6 “ ‘The person that turns to those who
are mediums and wizards, to play the
prostitute after them, I will even set my
face against that person, and will cut him
off from among his people.
7 “ ‘Sanctify yourselves therefore, and
be holy; for I am Yahweh your God.
8 You shall keep my statutes, and do
them. I am Yahweh who sanctifies you.
9 “ ‘For everyone who curses his father
or his mother shall surely be put to death.
He has cursed his father or his mother.
His blood shall be upon himself.
10 “ ‘The man who commits adultery
with another man’s wife, even he who
commits adultery with his neighbor’s
wife, the adulterer and the adulteress
shall surely be put to death.
11 “ ‘The man who lies with his father’s
wife has uncovered his father’s
nakedness. Both of them shall surely be
put to death. Their blood shall be upon
themselves.
12 “ ‘If a man lies with his
daughter-in-law, both of them shall surely
be put to death. They have committed a
perversion. Their blood shall be upon
themselves.
13 “ ‘If a man lies with a male, as with a
woman, both of them have committed an
abomination. They shall surely be put to
death. Their blood shall be upon
themselves.
14 “ ‘If a man takes a wife and her
mother, it is wickedness. They shall be
burned with fire, both he and they, that
there may be no wickedness among you.
15 “ ‘If a man lies with an animal, he
shall surely be put to death; and you shall
kill the animal.
16 “ ‘If a woman approaches any animal
and lies with it, you shall kill the woman
and the animal. They shall surely be put
to death. Their blood shall be upon them.
17 “ ‘If a man takes his sister—his father’s
daughter, or his mother’s daughter—and
sees her nakedness, and she sees his
nakedness, it is a shameful thing. They
shall be cut off in the sight of the children
of their people. He has uncovered his
sister’s nakedness. He shall bear his
iniquity.
18 “ ‘If a man lies with a woman having
her monthly period, and uncovers her
nakedness, he has made her fountain
naked, and she has uncovered the
fountain of her blood. Both of them shall
be cut off from among their people.
19 “ ‘You shall not uncover the
nakedness of your mother’s sister, nor of
your father’s sister, for he has made his
close relative naked. They shall bear their
iniquity.
20 If a man lies with his uncle’s wife, he
has uncovered his uncle’s nakedness.
They shall bear their sin. They shall die
childless.
21 “ ‘If a man takes his brother’s wife, it
is an impurity. He has uncovered his
brother’s nakedness. They shall be
childless.
22 “ ‘You shall therefore keep all my
statutes and all my ordinances, and do
them, that the land where I am bringing
you to dwell may not vomit you out.

† **20:2** or, seed

23 You shall not walk in the customs of
the nation which I am casting out before
you; for they did all these things, and
therefore I abhorred them.
24 But I have said to you, "You shall
inherit their land, and I will give it to you
to possess it, a land flowing with milk and
honey." I am Yahweh your God, who has
separated you from the peoples.
25 " 'You shall therefore make a
distinction between the clean animal and
the unclean, and between the unclean
fowl and the clean. You shall not make
yourselves abominable by animal, or by
bird, or by anything with which the
ground teems, which I have separated
from you as unclean for you.
26 You shall be holy to me, for I, Yahweh,
am holy, and have set you apart from the
peoples, that you should be mine.
27 " 'A man or a woman that is a
medium or is a wizard shall surely be put
to death. They shall be stoned with stones.
Their blood shall be upon themselves.' "

21

1 Yahweh said to Moses, "Speak to the
priests, the sons of Aaron, and say to
them, 'A priest shall not defile himself for
the dead among his people,
2 except for his relatives that are near to
him: for his mother, for his father, for his
son, for his daughter, for his brother,
3 and for his virgin sister who is near to
him, who has had no husband; for her he
may defile himself.
4 He shall not defile himself, being a
chief man among his people, to profane
himself.
5 " 'They shall not shave their heads or
shave off the corners of their beards or
make any cuttings in their flesh.
6 They shall be holy to their God, and
not profane the name of their God, for
they offer the offerings of Yahweh made
by fire, the bread of their God. Therefore
they shall be holy.
7 " 'They shall not marry a woman who
is a prostitute, or profane. A priest shall
not marry a woman divorced from her
husband; for he is holy to his God.
8 Therefore you shall sanctify him, for
he offers the bread of your God. He shall
be holy to you, for I Yahweh, who sanctify
you, am holy.
9 " 'The daughter of any priest, if she
profanes herself by playing the prostitute,
she profanes her father. She shall be
burned with fire.
10 " 'He who is the high priest among his
brothers, upon whose head the anointing
oil is poured, and who is consecrated to
put on the garments, shall not let the hair
of his head hang loose, or tear his clothes.
11 He must not go in to any dead body,
or defile himself for his father or for his
mother.
12 He shall not go out of the sanctuary,
nor profane the sanctuary of his God; for
the crown of the anointing oil of his God is
upon him. I am Yahweh.
13 " 'He shall take a wife in her virginity.
14 He shall not marry a widow, or one
divorced, or a woman who has been
defiled, or a prostitute. He shall take a
virgin of his own people as a wife.
15 He shall not profane his offspring
among his people, for I am Yahweh who
sanctifies him.' "
16 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
17 "Say to Aaron, 'None of your offspring
throughout their generations who has a
defect may approach to offer the bread of
his God.
18 For whatever man he is that has a
defect, he shall not draw near: a blind
man, or a lame, or he who has a flat nose,
or any deformity,
19 or a man who has an injured foot, or
an injured hand,
20 or hunchbacked, or a dwarf, or one
who has a defect in his eye, or an itching
disease, or scabs, or who has damaged
testicles.
21 No man of the offspring of Aaron the
priest who has a defect shall come near to
offer the offerings of Yahweh made by
fire. Since he has a defect, he shall not
come near to offer the bread of his God.
22 He shall eat the bread of his God, both
of the most holy, and of the holy.
23 He shall not come near to the veil, nor
come near to the altar, because he has a

defect; that he may not profane my sanctuaries, for I am Yahweh who sanctifies them.' "
24 So Moses spoke to Aaron, and to his sons, and to all the children of Israel.

22

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Tell Aaron and his sons to separate themselves from the holy things of the children of Israel, which they make holy to me, and that they not profane my holy name. I am Yahweh.
3 "Tell them, 'If anyone of all your offspring throughout your generations approaches the holy things which the children of Israel make holy to Yahweh, having his uncleanness on him, that soul shall be cut off from before me. I am Yahweh.
4 " 'Whoever of the offspring of Aaron is a leper or has a discharge shall not eat of the holy things until he is clean. Whoever touches anything that is unclean by the dead, or a man who has a seminal emission,
5 or whoever touches any creeping thing by which he may be made unclean, or a man from whom he may become unclean, whatever uncleanness he has—
6 the person that touches any such shall be unclean until the evening, and shall not eat of the holy things unless he bathes his body in water.
7 When the sun is down, he shall be clean; and afterward he shall eat of the holy things, because it is his bread.
8 He shall not eat that which dies of itself or is torn by animals, defiling himself by it. I am Yahweh.
9 " 'They shall therefore follow my commandment, lest they bear sin for it and die in it, if they profane it. I am Yahweh who sanctifies them.
10 " 'No stranger shall eat of the holy thing: a foreigner living with the priests, or a hired servant, shall not eat of the holy thing.
11 But if a priest buys a slave, purchased by his money, he shall eat of it; and those who are born in his house shall eat of his bread.
12 If a priest's daughter is married to an outsider, she shall not eat of the heave offering of the holy things.
13 But if a priest's daughter is a widow, or divorced, and has no child, and has returned to her father's house as in her youth, she may eat of her father's bread; but no stranger shall eat any of it.
14 " 'If a man eats something holy unwittingly, then he shall add the fifth part of its value to it, and shall give the holy thing to the priest.
15 The priests shall not profane the holy things of the children of Israel, which they offer to Yahweh,
16 and so cause them to bear the iniquity that brings guilt when they eat their holy things; for I am Yahweh who sanctifies them.' "
17 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
18 "Speak to Aaron, and to his sons, and to all the children of Israel, and say to them, 'Whoever is of the house of Israel, or of the foreigners in Israel, who offers his offering, whether it is any of their vows or any of their free will offerings, which they offer to Yahweh for a burnt offering:
19 that you may be accepted, you shall offer a male without defect, of the bulls, of the sheep, or of the goats.
20 But you shall not offer whatever has a defect, for it shall not be acceptable for you.
21 Whoever offers a sacrifice of peace offerings to Yahweh to accomplish a vow, or for a free will offering of the herd or of the flock, it shall be perfect to be accepted. It shall have no defect.
22 You shall not offer what is blind, is injured, is maimed, has a wart, is festering, or has a running sore to Yahweh, nor make an offering by fire of them on the altar to Yahweh.
23 Either a bull or a lamb that has any deformity or lacking in his parts, that you may offer for a free will offering; but for a vow it shall not be accepted.
24 You must not offer to Yahweh that which has its testicles bruised, crushed, broken, or cut. You must not do this in your land.

25 You must not offer any of these as the
bread of your God from the hand of a
foreigner, because their corruption is in
them. There is a defect in them. They shall
not be accepted for you.' "
26 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
27 "When a bull, a sheep, or a goat is
born, it shall remain seven days with its
mother. From the eighth day on it shall be
accepted for the offering of an offering
made by fire to Yahweh.
28 Whether it is a cow or ewe, you shall
not kill it and its young both in one day.
29 "When you sacrifice a sacrifice of
thanksgiving to Yahweh, you shall
sacrifice it so that you may be accepted.
30 It shall be eaten on the same day; you
shall leave none of it until the morning. I
am Yahweh.
31 "Therefore you shall keep my
commandments, and do them. I am
Yahweh.
32 You shall not profane my holy name,
but I will be made holy among the
children of Israel. I am Yahweh who
makes you holy,
33 who brought you out of the land of
Egypt, to be your God. I am Yahweh."

23

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them, 'The set feasts of Yahweh, which
you shall proclaim to be holy
convocations, even these are my set feasts.
3 " 'Six days shall work be done, but on
the seventh day is a Sabbath of solemn
rest, a holy convocation; you shall do no
kind of work. It is a Sabbath to Yahweh in
all your dwellings.
4 " 'These are the set feasts of Yahweh,
even holy convocations, which you shall
proclaim in their appointed season.
5 In the first month, on the fourteenth
day of the month in the evening, is
Yahweh's Passover.
6 On the fifteenth day of the same month
is the feast of unleavened bread to
Yahweh. Seven days you shall eat
unleavened bread.
7 In the first day you shall have a holy
convocation. You shall do no regular
work.
8 But you shall offer an offering made
by fire to Yahweh seven days. In the
seventh day is a holy convocation. You
shall do no regular work.' "
9 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
10 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them, 'When you have come into the
land which I give to you, and shall reap its
harvest, then you shall bring the sheaf of
the first fruits of your harvest to the priest.
11 He shall wave the sheaf before
Yahweh, to be accepted for you. On the
next day after the Sabbath the priest shall
wave it.
12 On the day when you wave the sheaf,
you shall offer a male lamb without defect
a year old for a burnt offering to Yahweh.
13 The meal offering with it shall be two
tenths of an ephah† of fine flour mixed
with oil, an offering made by fire to
Yahweh for a pleasant aroma; and the
drink offering with it shall be of wine, the
fourth part of a hin.‡
14 You must not eat bread, or roasted
grain, or fresh grain, until this same day,
until you have brought the offering of
your God. This is a statute forever
throughout your generations in all your
dwellings.
15 " 'You shall count from the next day
after the Sabbath, from the day that you
brought the sheaf of the wave offering:
seven Sabbaths shall be completed.
16 The next day after the seventh
Sabbath you shall count fifty days; and
you shall offer a new meal offering to
Yahweh.
17 You shall bring out of your
habitations two loaves of bread for a
wave offering made of two tenths of an
ephah§ of fine flour. They shall be baked
with yeast, for first fruits to Yahweh.
18 You shall present with the bread
seven lambs without defect a year old,

† **23:13** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel
1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel
‡ **23:13** A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons. § **23:17**

one young bull, and two rams. They shall be a burnt offering to Yahweh, with their meal offering and their drink offerings, even an offering made by fire, of a sweet aroma to Yahweh.
19 You shall offer one male goat for a sin offering, and two male lambs a year old for a sacrifice of peace offerings.
20 The priest shall wave them with the bread of the first fruits for a wave offering before Yahweh, with the two lambs. They shall be holy to Yahweh for the priest.
21 You shall make proclamation on the same day that there shall be a holy convocation to you. You shall do no regular work. This is a statute forever in all your dwellings throughout your generations.
22 " 'When you reap the harvest of your land, you must not wholly reap into the corners of your field. You must not gather the gleanings of your harvest. You must leave them for the poor and for the foreigner. I am Yahweh your God.' "
23 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
24 "Speak to the children of Israel, saying, 'In the seventh month, on the first day of the month, there shall be a solemn rest for you, a memorial of blowing of trumpets, a holy convocation.
25 You shall do no regular work. You shall offer an offering made by fire to Yahweh.' "
26 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
27 "However on the tenth day of this seventh month is the day of atonement. It shall be a holy convocation to you. You shall afflict yourselves and you shall offer an offering made by fire to Yahweh.
28 You shall do no kind of work in that same day, for it is a day of atonement, to make atonement for you before Yahweh your God.
29 For whoever it is who shall not deny himself in that same day shall be cut off from his people.
30 Whoever does any kind of work in that same day, I will destroy that person from among his people.
31 You shall do no kind of work: it is a statute forever throughout your generations in all your dwellings.
32 It shall be a Sabbath of solemn rest for you, and you shall deny yourselves. In the ninth day of the month at evening, from evening to evening, you shall keep your Sabbath."

33 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
34 "Speak to the children of Israel, and say, 'On the fifteenth day of this seventh month is the feast of booths† for seven days to Yahweh.
35 On the first day shall be a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work.
36 Seven days you shall offer an offering made by fire to Yahweh. On the eighth day shall be a holy convocation to you. You shall offer an offering made by fire to Yahweh. It is a solemn assembly; you shall do no regular work.

37 " 'These are the appointed feasts of Yahweh which you shall proclaim to be holy convocations, to offer an offering made by fire to Yahweh, a burnt offering, a meal offering, a sacrifice, and drink offerings, each on its own day—
38 in addition to the Sabbaths of Yahweh, and in addition to your gifts, and in addition to all your vows, and in addition to all your free will offerings, which you give to Yahweh.

39 " 'So on the fifteenth day of the seventh month, when you have gathered in the fruits of the land, you shall keep the feast of Yahweh seven days. On the first day shall be a solemn rest, and on the eighth day shall be a solemn rest.
40 You shall take on the first day the fruit of majestic trees, branches of palm trees, and boughs of thick trees, and willows of the brook; and you shall rejoice before Yahweh your God seven days.
41 You shall keep it as a feast to Yahweh seven days in the year. It is a statute forever throughout your generations. You shall keep it in the seventh month.

† **23:34** or, feast of tents, or Succoth ‡ **23:42** or, booths § **23:42** or, booths

42 You shall dwell in temporary shelters‡ for seven days. All who are native-born in
Israel shall dwell in temporary shelters,§
43 that your generations may know that
I made the children of Israel to dwell in
temporary shelters† when I brought them
out of the land of Egypt. I am Yahweh
your God.' "
44 So Moses declared to the children of
Israel the appointed feasts of Yahweh.

24

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Command the children of Israel, that
they bring to you pure olive oil beaten for
the light, to cause a lamp to burn
continually.
3 Outside of the veil of the Testimony, in
the Tent of Meeting, Aaron shall keep it in
order from evening to morning before
Yahweh continually. It shall be a statute
forever throughout your generations.
4 He shall keep in order the lamps on the
pure gold lamp stand before Yahweh
continually.
5 "You shall take fine flour, and bake
twelve cakes of it: two tenths of an ephah†
shall be in one cake.
6 You shall set them in two rows, six on a
row, on the pure gold table before
Yahweh.
7 You shall put pure frankincense on
each row, that it may be to the bread for a
memorial, even an offering made by fire
to Yahweh.
8 Every Sabbath day he shall set it in
order before Yahweh continually. It is an
everlasting covenant on the behalf of the
children of Israel.
9 It shall be for Aaron and his sons. They
shall eat it in a holy place; for it is most
holy to him of the offerings of Yahweh
made by fire by a perpetual statute."
10 The son of an Israelite woman, whose
father was an Egyptian, went out among
the children of Israel; and the son of the
Israelite woman and a man of Israel
strove together in the camp.
11 The son of the Israelite woman
blasphemed the Name, and cursed; and
they brought him to Moses. His mother's
name was Shelomith, the daughter of
Dibri, of the tribe of Dan.
12 They put him in custody until
Yahweh's will should be declared to them.
13 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
14 "Bring him who cursed out of the
camp; and let all who heard him lay their
hands on his head, and let all the
congregation stone him.
15 You shall speak to the children of
Israel, saying, 'Whoever curses his God
shall bear his sin.
16 He who blasphemes Yahweh's name,
he shall surely be put to death. All the
congregation shall certainly stone him.
The foreigner as well as the native-born
shall be put to death when he blasphemes
the Name.
17 " 'He who strikes any man mortally
shall surely be put to death.
18 He who strikes an animal mortally
shall make it good, life for life.
19 If anyone injures his neighbor, it shall
be done to him as he has done:
20 fracture for fracture, eye for eye,
tooth for tooth. It shall be done to him as
he has injured someone.
21 He who kills an animal shall make it
good; and he who kills a man shall be put
to death.
22 You shall have one kind of law for the
foreigner as well as the native-born; for I
am Yahweh your God.' "
23 Moses spoke to the children of Israel;
and they brought him who had cursed out
of the camp, and stoned him with stones.
The children of Israel did as Yahweh
commanded Moses.

25

1 Yahweh said to Moses on Mount Sinai,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them, 'When you come into the land
which I give you, then the land shall keep
a Sabbath to Yahweh.
3 You shall sow your field six years, and
you shall prune your vineyard six years,
and gather in its fruits;
4 but in the seventh year there shall be a
Sabbath of solemn rest for the land, a

† **23:43** or, booths † **24:5** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

Sabbath to Yahweh. You shall not sow your field or prune your vineyard.
5 What grows of itself in your harvest you shall not reap, and you shall not gather the grapes of your undressed vine. It shall be a year of solemn rest for the land.
6 The Sabbath of the land shall be for food for you; for yourself, for your servant, for your maid, for your hired servant, and for your stranger, who lives as a foreigner with you.
7 For your livestock also, and for the animals that are in your land, shall all its increase be for food.
8 “ ‘You shall count off seven Sabbaths of years, seven times seven years; and there shall be to you the days of seven Sabbaths of years, even forty-nine years.
9 Then you shall sound the loud trumpet on the tenth day of the seventh month. On the Day of Atonement you shall sound the trumpet throughout all your land.
10 You shall make the fiftieth year holy, and proclaim liberty throughout the land to all its inhabitants. It shall be a jubilee to you; and each of you shall return to his own property, and each of you shall return to his family.
11 That fiftieth year shall be a jubilee to you. In it you shall not sow, neither reap that which grows of itself, nor gather from the undressed vines.
12 For it is a jubilee; it shall be holy to you. You shall eat of its increase out of the field.
13 “ ‘In this Year of Jubilee each of you shall return to his property.
14 “ ‘If you sell anything to your neighbor, or buy from your neighbor, you shall not wrong one another.
15 According to the number of years after the Jubilee you shall buy from your neighbor. According to the number of years of the crops he shall sell to you.
16 According to the length of the years you shall increase its price, and according to the shortness of the years you shall diminish its price; for he is selling the number of the crops to you.
17 You shall not wrong one another, but you shall fear your God; for I am Yahweh your God.
18 “ ‘Therefore you shall do my statutes, and keep my ordinances and do them; and you shall dwell in the land in safety.
19 The land shall yield its fruit, and you shall eat your fill, and dwell therein in safety.
20 If you said, “What shall we eat the seventh year? Behold, we shall not sow, nor gather in our increase;”
21 then I will command my blessing on you in the sixth year, and it shall bear fruit for the three years.
22 You shall sow the eighth year, and eat of the fruits from the old store until the ninth year. Until its fruits come in, you shall eat the old store.
23 “ ‘The land shall not be sold in perpetuity, for the land is mine; for you are strangers and live as foreigners with me.
24 In all the land of your possession you shall grant a redemption for the land.
25 “ ‘If your brother becomes poor, and sells some of his possessions, then his kinsman who is next to him shall come, and redeem that which his brother has sold.
26 If a man has no one to redeem it, and he becomes prosperous and finds sufficient means to redeem it,
27 then let him reckon the years since its sale, and restore the surplus to the man to whom he sold it; and he shall return to his property.
28 But if he isn’t able to get it back for himself, then what he has sold shall remain in the hand of him who has bought it until the Year of Jubilee. In the Jubilee it shall be released, and he shall return to his property.
29 “ ‘If a man sells a dwelling house in a walled city, then he may redeem it within a whole year after it has been sold. For a full year he shall have the right of redemption.
30 If it isn’t redeemed within the space of a full year, then the house that is in the walled city shall be made sure in perpetuity to him who bought it,

throughout his generations. It shall not be
released in the Jubilee.
31 But the houses of the villages which
have no wall around them shall be
accounted for with the fields of the
country: they may be redeemed, and they
shall be released in the Jubilee.
32 " 'Nevertheless, in the cities of the
Levites, the Levites may redeem the
houses in the cities of their possession at
any time.
33 The Levites may redeem the house
that was sold, and the city of his
possession, and it shall be released in the
Jubilee; for the houses of the cities of the
Levites are their possession among the
children of Israel.
34 But the field of the pasture lands of
their cities may not be sold, for it is their
perpetual possession.
35 " 'If your brother has become poor,
and his hand can't support himself among
you, then you shall uphold him. He shall
live with you like an alien and a
temporary resident.
36 Take no interest from him or profit;
but fear your God, that your brother may
live among you.
37 You shall not lend him your money at
interest, nor give him your food for profit.
38 I am Yahweh your God, who brought
you out of the land of Egypt, to give you
the land of Canaan, and to be your God.
39 " 'If your brother has grown poor
among you, and sells himself to you, you
shall not make him to serve as a slave.
40 As a hired servant, and as a
temporary resident, he shall be with you;
he shall serve with you until the Year of
Jubilee.
41 Then he shall go out from you, he and
his children with him, and shall return to
his own family, and to the possession of
his fathers.
42 For they are my servants, whom I
brought out of the land of Egypt. They
shall not be sold as slaves.
43 You shall not rule over him with
harshness, but shall fear your God.
44 " 'As for your male and your female
slaves, whom you may have from the
nations that are around you, from them
you may buy male and female slaves.
45 Moreover, of the children of the aliens
who live among you, of them you may
buy, and of their families who are with
you, which they have conceived in your
land; and they will be your property.
46 You may make them an inheritance
for your children after you, to hold for a
possession. Of them you may take your
slaves forever, but over your brothers the
children of Israel you shall not rule, one
over another, with harshness.
47 " 'If an alien or temporary resident
with you becomes rich, and your brother
beside him has grown poor, and sells
himself to the stranger or foreigner living
among you, or to a member of the
stranger's family,
48 after he is sold he may be redeemed.
One of his brothers may redeem him;
49 or his uncle, or his uncle's son, may
redeem him, or any who is a close relative
to him of his family may redeem him; or if
he has grown rich, he may redeem
himself.
50 He shall reckon with him who bought
him from the year that he sold himself to
him to the Year of Jubilee. The price of his
sale shall be according to the number of
years; he shall be with him according to
the time of a hired servant.
51 If there are yet many years, according
to them he shall give back the price of his
redemption out of the money that he was
bought for.
52 If there remain but a few years to the
year of jubilee, then he shall reckon with
him; according to his years of service he
shall give back the price of his
redemption.
53 As a servant hired year by year shall
he be with him. He shall not rule with
harshness over him in your sight.
54 If he isn't redeemed by these means,
then he shall be released in the Year of
Jubilee: he and his children with him.
55 For to me the children of Israel are
servants; they are my servants whom I
brought out of the land of Egypt. I am
Yahweh your God.

26

1 “ ‘You shall make for yourselves no
idols, and you shall not raise up a carved
image or a pillar, and you shall not place
any figured stone in your land, to bow
down to it; for I am Yahweh your God.
2 “ ‘You shall keep my Sabbaths, and
have reverence for my sanctuary. I am
Yahweh.
3 “ ‘If you walk in my statutes and keep
my commandments, and do them,
4 then I will give you your rains in their
season, and the land shall yield its
increase, and the trees of the field shall
yield their fruit.
5 Your threshing shall continue until the
vintage, and the vintage shall continue
until the sowing time. You shall eat your
bread to the full, and dwell in your land
safely.
6 “ ‘I will give peace in the land, and you
shall lie down, and no one will make you
afraid. I will remove evil animals out of
the land, neither shall the sword go
through your land.
7 You shall chase your enemies, and
they shall fall before you by the sword.
8 Five of you shall chase a hundred, and
a hundred of you shall chase ten
thousand; and your enemies shall fall
before you by the sword.
9 “ ‘I will have respect for you, make you
fruitful, multiply you, and will establish
my covenant with you.
10 You shall eat old supplies long kept,
and you shall move out the old because of
the new.
11 I will set my tent among you, and my
soul won’t abhor you.
12 I will walk among you, and will be
your God, and you will be my people.
13 I am Yahweh your God, who brought
you out of the land of Egypt, that you
should not be their slaves. I have broken
the bars of your yoke, and made you walk
upright.
14 “ ‘But if you will not listen to me, and
will not do all these commandments,
15 and if you shall reject my statutes,
and if your soul abhors my ordinances, so
that you will not do all my
commandments, but break my covenant,
16 I also will do this to you: I will appoint
terror over you, even consumption and
fever, that shall consume the eyes, and
make the soul to pine away. You will sow
your seed in vain, for your enemies will
eat it.
17 I will set my face against you, and you
will be struck before your enemies. Those
who hate you will rule over you; and you
will flee when no one pursues you.
18 “ ‘If you in spite of these things will
not listen to me, then I will chastise you
seven times more for your sins.
19 I will break the pride of your power,
and I will make your sky like iron, and
your soil like bronze.
20 Your strength will be spent in vain;
for your land won’t yield its increase,
neither will the trees of the land yield
their fruit.
21 “ ‘If you walk contrary to me, and
won’t listen to me, then I will bring seven
times more plagues on you according to
your sins.
22 I will send the wild animals among
you, which will rob you of your children,
destroy your livestock, and make you few
in number. Your roads will become
desolate.
23 “ ‘If by these things you won’t be
turned back to me, but will walk contrary
to me,
24 then I will also walk contrary to you;
and I will strike you, even I, seven times
for your sins.
25 I will bring a sword upon you that
will execute the vengeance of the
covenant. You will be gathered together
within your cities, and I will send the
pestilence among you. You will be
delivered into the hand of the enemy.
26 When I break your staff of bread, ten
women shall bake your bread in one oven,
and they shall deliver your bread again by
weight. You shall eat, and not be satisfied.
27 “ ‘If you in spite of this won’t listen to
me, but walk contrary to me,

28 then I will walk contrary to you in
wrath. I will also chastise you seven times
for your sins.
29 You will eat the flesh of your sons, and
you will eat the flesh of your daughters.
30 I will destroy your high places, and
cut down your incense altars, and cast
your dead bodies upon the bodies of your
idols; and my soul will abhor you.
31 I will lay your cities waste, and will
bring your sanctuaries to desolation. I
will not take delight in the sweet
fragrance of your offerings.
32 I will bring the land into desolation,
and your enemies who dwell in it will be
astonished at it.
33 I will scatter you among the nations,
and I will draw out the sword after you.
Your land will be a desolation, and your
cities shall be a waste.
34 Then the land will enjoy its Sabbaths
as long as it lies desolate and you are in
your enemies' land. Even then the land
will rest and enjoy its Sabbaths.
35 As long as it lies desolate it shall have
rest, even the rest which it didn't have in
your Sabbaths when you lived on it.

36 " 'As for those of you who are left, I
will send a faintness into their hearts in
the lands of their enemies. The sound of a
driven leaf will put them to flight; and
they shall flee, as one flees from the
sword. They will fall when no one
pursues.
37 They will stumble over one another,
as it were before the sword, when no one
pursues. You will have no power to stand
before your enemies.
38 You will perish among the nations.
The land of your enemies will eat you up.
39 Those of you who are left will pine
away in their iniquity in your enemies'
lands; and also in the iniquities of their
fathers they shall pine away with them.

40 " 'If they confess their iniquity and
the iniquity of their fathers, in their
trespass which they trespassed against
me; and also that because they walked
contrary to me,
41 I also walked contrary to them, and
brought them into the land of their
enemies; if then their uncircumcised
heart is humbled, and they then accept
the punishment of their iniquity,
42 then I will remember my covenant
with Jacob, my covenant with Isaac, and
also my covenant with Abraham; and I
will remember the land.
43 The land also will be left by them, and
will enjoy its Sabbaths while it lies
desolate without them; and they will
accept the punishment of their iniquity
because they rejected my ordinances, and
their soul abhorred my statutes.
44 Yet for all that, when they are in the
land of their enemies, I will not reject
them, neither will I abhor them, to destroy
them utterly and to break my covenant
with them; for I am Yahweh their God.
45 But I will for their sake remember the
covenant of their ancestors, whom I
brought out of the land of Egypt in the
sight of the nations, that I might be their
God. I am Yahweh.' "
46 These are the statutes, ordinances,
and laws, which Yahweh made between
him and the children of Israel in Mount
Sinai by Moses.

27

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
say to them, 'When a man consecrates a
person to Yahweh in a vow, according to
your valuation,
3 your valuation of a male from twenty
years old to sixty years old shall be fifty
shekels of silver, according to the shekel†
of the sanctuary.
4 If she is a female, then your valuation
shall be thirty shekels.
5 If the person is from five years old to
twenty years old, then your valuation
shall be for a male twenty shekels, and for
a female ten shekels.
6 If the person is from a month old to
five years old, then your valuation shall
be for a male five shekels of silver, and for

† **27:3** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

a female your valuation shall be three shekels of silver.
7 If the person is from sixty years old and upward; if he is a male, then your valuation shall be fifteen shekels, and for a female ten shekels.
8 But if he is poorer than your valuation, then he shall be set before the priest, and the priest shall assign a value to him. The priest shall assign a value according to his ability to pay.

9 " 'If it is an animal of which men offer an offering to Yahweh, all that any man gives of such to Yahweh becomes holy.
10 He shall not alter it, nor exchange it, a good for a bad, or a bad for a good. If he shall at all exchange animal for animal, then both it and that for which it is exchanged shall be holy.
11 If it is any unclean animal, of which they do not offer as an offering to Yahweh, then he shall set the animal before the priest;
12 and the priest shall evaluate it, whether it is good or bad. As the priest evaluates it, so it shall be.
13 But if he will indeed redeem it, then he shall add the fifth part of it to its valuation.
14 " 'When a man dedicates his house to be holy to Yahweh, then the priest shall evaluate it, whether it is good or bad. As the priest evaluates it, so it shall stand.
15 If he who dedicates it will redeem his house, then he shall add the fifth part of the money of your valuation to it, and it shall be his.
16 " 'If a man dedicates to Yahweh part of the field of his possession, then your valuation shall be according to the seed for it. The sowing of a homer‡ of barley shall be valued at fifty shekels§ of silver.
17 If he dedicates his field from the Year of Jubilee, according to your valuation it shall stand.
18 But if he dedicates his field after the Jubilee, then the priest shall reckon to him the money according to the years that remain to the Year of Jubilee; and an abatement shall be made from your valuation.
19 If he who dedicated the field will indeed redeem it, then he shall add the fifth part of the money of your valuation to it, and it shall remain his.
20 If he will not redeem the field, or if he has sold the field to another man, it shall not be redeemed any more;
21 but the field, when it goes out in the Jubilee, shall be holy to Yahweh, as a devoted field. It shall be owned by the priests.

22 " 'If he dedicates a field to Yahweh which he has bought, which is not of the field of his possession,
23 then the priest shall reckon to him the worth of your valuation up to the Year of Jubilee; and he shall give your valuation on that day, as a holy thing to Yahweh.
24 In the Year of Jubilee the field shall return to him from whom it was bought, even to him to whom the possession of the land belongs.
25 All your valuations shall be according to the shekel of the sanctuary: twenty gerahs† to the shekel.‡

26 " 'However the firstborn among animals, which belongs to Yahweh as a firstborn, no man may dedicate, whether an ox or a sheep. It is Yahweh's.
27 If it is an unclean animal, then he shall buy it back according to your valuation, and shall add to it the fifth part of it; or if it isn't redeemed, then it shall be sold according to your valuation.

28 " 'Notwithstanding, no devoted thing that a man devotes to Yahweh of all that he has, whether of man or animal, or of the field of his possession, shall be sold or redeemed. Everything that is permanently devoted is most holy to Yahweh.

29 " 'No one devoted to destruction, who shall be devoted from among men, shall be ransomed. He shall surely be put to death.

‡ **27:16** 1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels § **27:16** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. † **27:25** A gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains. ‡ **27:25** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

30 “ ‘All the tithe of the land, whether of
the seed of the land or of the fruit of the
trees, is Yahweh’s. It is holy to Yahweh.
31 If a man redeems anything of his
tithe, he shall add a fifth part to it.
32 All the tithe of the herds or the flocks,
whatever passes under the rod, the tenth
shall be holy to Yahweh.
33 He shall not examine whether it is
good or bad, neither shall he exchange it.
If he exchanges it at all, then both it and
that for which it is exchanged shall be
holy. It shall not be redeemed.’ ”
34 These are the commandments which
Yahweh commanded Moses for the
children of Israel on Mount Sinai.

The Fourth Book of Moses, Commonly Called Numbers

1 Yahweh† spoke to Moses in the
wilderness of Sinai, in the Tent of
Meeting, on the first day of the second
month, in the second year after they had
come out of the land of Egypt, saying,
2 "Take a census of all the congregation
of the children of Israel, by their families,
by their fathers' houses, according to the
number of the names, every male, one by
one,
3 from twenty years old and upward, all
who are able to go out to war in Israel.
You and Aaron shall count them by their
divisions.
4 With you there shall be a man of every
tribe, each one head of his fathers' house.
5 These are the names of the men who
shall stand with you:
Of Reuben: Elizur the son of Shedeur.
6 Of Simeon: Shelumiel the son of
Zurishaddai.
7 Of Judah: Nahshon the son of
Amminadab.
8 Of Issachar: Nethanel the son of Zuar.
9 Of Zebulun: Eliab the son of Helon.
10 Of the children of Joseph: of Ephraim:
Elishama the son of Ammihud; of
Manasseh: Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur.
11 Of Benjamin: Abidan the son of
Gideoni.
12 Of Dan: Ahiezer the son of
Ammishaddai.
13 Of Asher: Pagiel the son of Ochran.
14 Of Gad: Eliasaph the son of Deuel.
15 Of Naphtali: Ahira the son of Enan."
16 These are those who were called of
the congregation, the princes‡ of the
tribes of their fathers; they were the
heads of the thousands of Israel.
17 Moses and Aaron took these men who
are mentioned by name.
18 They assembled all the congregation
together on the first day of the second
month; and they declared their ancestry
by their families, by their fathers' houses,
according to the number of the names,
from twenty years old and upward, one
by one.
19 As Yahweh commanded Moses, so he
counted them in the wilderness of Sinai.
20 The children of Reuben, Israel's
firstborn, their generations, by their
families, by their fathers' houses,
according to the number of the names,
one by one, every male from twenty years
old and upward, all who were able to go
out to war:
21 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Reuben, were forty-six
thousand five hundred.
22 Of the children of Simeon, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, those who were counted
of it, according to the number of the
names, one by one, every male from
twenty years old and upward, all who
were able to go out to war:
23 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Simeon, were fifty-nine
thousand three hundred.
24 Of the children of Gad, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, according to the number
of the names, from twenty years old and
upward, all who were able to go out to
war:
25 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Gad, were forty-five thousand
six hundred fifty.
26 Of the children of Judah, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, according to the number
of the names, from twenty years old and
upward, all who were able to go out to
war:
27 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Judah, were seventy-four
thousand six hundred.
28 Of the children of Issachar, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, according to the number
of the names, from twenty years old and
upward, all who were able to go out to
war:

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:16** or, chiefs, or, leaders

29 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Issachar, were fifty-four
thousand four hundred.
30 Of the children of Zebulun, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, according to the number
of the names, from twenty years old and
upward, all who were able to go out to
war:
31 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Zebulun, were fifty-seven
thousand four hundred.
32 Of the children of Joseph: of the
children of Ephraim, their generations, by
their families, by their fathers' houses,
according to the number of the names,
from twenty years old and upward, all
who were able to go out to war:
33 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Ephraim, were forty thousand
five hundred.
34 Of the children of Manasseh, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, according to the number
of the names, from twenty years old and
upward, all who were able to go out to
war:
35 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Manasseh, were thirty-two
thousand two hundred.
36 Of the children of Benjamin, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, according to the number
of the names, from twenty years old and
upward, all who were able to go out to
war:
37 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Benjamin, were thirty-five
thousand four hundred.
38 Of the children of Dan, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, according to the number
of the names, from twenty years old and
upward, all who were able to go out to
war:
39 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Dan, were sixty-two thousand
seven hundred.
40 Of the children of Asher, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, according to the number
of the names, from twenty years old and
upward, all who were able to go out to
war:
41 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Asher, were forty-one
thousand five hundred.
42 Of the children of Naphtali, their
generations, by their families, by their
fathers' houses, according to the number
of the names, from twenty years old and
upward, all who were able to go out to
war:
43 those who were counted of them, of
the tribe of Naphtali, were fifty-three
thousand four hundred.
44 These are those who were counted,
whom Moses and Aaron counted, and the
twelve men who were princes of Israel,
each one for his fathers' house.
45 So all those who were counted of the
children of Israel by their fathers' houses,
from twenty years old and upward, all
who were able to go out to war in Israel—
46 all those who were counted were six
hundred three thousand five hundred
fifty.
47 But the Levites after the tribe of their
fathers were not counted among them.
48 For Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
49 "Only the tribe of Levi you shall not
count, neither shall you take a census of
them among the children of Israel;
50 but appoint the Levites over the
Tabernacle of the Testimony, and over all
its furnishings, and over all that belongs
to it. They shall carry the tabernacle and
all its furnishings; and they shall take care
of it, and shall encamp around it.
51 When the tabernacle is to move, the
Levites shall take it down; and when the
tabernacle is to be set up, the Levites shall
set it up. The stranger who comes near
shall be put to death.
52 The children of Israel shall pitch their
tents, every man by his own camp, and
every man by his own standard,
according to their divisions.
53 But the Levites shall encamp around
the Tabernacle of the Testimony, that
there may be no wrath on the
congregation of the children of Israel. The
Levites shall be responsible for the
Tabernacle of the Testimony."

54 Thus the children of Israel did.
According to all that Yahweh commanded
Moses, so they did.

2

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
saying,
2 "The children of Israel shall encamp
every man by his own standard, with the
banners of their fathers' houses. They
shall encamp around the Tent of Meeting
at a distance from it.
3 "Those who encamp on the east side
toward the sunrise shall be of the
standard of the camp of Judah, according
to their divisions. The prince of the
children of Judah shall be Nahshon the
son of Amminadab.
4 His division, and those who were
counted of them, were seventy-four
thousand six hundred.
5 "Those who encamp next to him shall
be the tribe of Issachar. The prince of the
children of Issachar shall be Nethanel the
son of Zuar.
6 His division, and those who were
counted of it, were fifty-four thousand
four hundred.
7 "The tribe of Zebulun: the prince of
the children of Zebulun shall be Eliab the
son of Helon.
8 His division, and those who were
counted of it, were fifty-seven thousand
four hundred.
9 "All who were counted of the camp of
Judah were one hundred eighty-six
thousand four hundred, according to
their divisions. They shall set out first.
10 "On the south side shall be the
standard of the camp of Reuben
according to their divisions. The prince of
the children of Reuben shall be Elizur the
son of Shedeur.
11 His division, and those who were
counted of it, were forty-six thousand five
hundred.
12 "Those who encamp next to him shall
be the tribe of Simeon. The prince of the
children of Simeon shall be Shelumiel the
son of Zurishaddai.
13 His division, and those who were
counted of them, were fifty-nine thousand
three hundred.
14 "The tribe of Gad: the prince of the
children of Gad shall be Eliasaph the son
of Reuel.
15 His division, and those who were
counted of them, were forty-five thousand
six hundred fifty.
16 "All who were counted of the camp of
Reuben were one hundred fifty-one
thousand four hundred fifty, according to
their armies. They shall set out second.
17 "Then the Tent of Meeting shall set
out, with the camp of the Levites in the
middle of the camps. As they encamp, so
shall they set out, every man in his place,
by their standards.
18 "On the west side shall be the
standard of the camp of Ephraim
according to their divisions. The prince of
the children of Ephraim shall be Elishama
the son of Ammihud.
19 His division, and those who were
counted of them, were forty thousand five
hundred.
20 "Next to him shall be the tribe of
Manasseh. The prince of the children of
Manasseh shall be Gamaliel the son of
Pedahzur.
21 His division, and those who were
counted of them, were thirty-two
thousand two hundred.
22 "The tribe of Benjamin: the prince of
the children of Benjamin shall be Abidan
the son of Gideoni.
23 His army, and those who were
counted of them, were thirty-five
thousand four hundred.
24 "All who were counted of the camp of
Ephraim were one hundred eight
thousand one hundred, according to their
divisions. They shall set out third.
25 "On the north side shall be the
standard of the camp of Dan according to
their divisions. The prince of the children
of Dan shall be Ahiezer the son of
Ammishaddai.
26 His division, and those who were
counted of them, were sixty-two thousand
seven hundred.
27 "Those who encamp next to him shall
be the tribe of Asher. The prince of the
children of Asher shall be Pagiel the son of
Ochran.

28 His division, and those who were
counted of them, were forty-one thousand
five hundred.
29 "The tribe of Naphtali: the prince of
the children of Naphtali shall be Ahira the
son of Enan.
30 His division, and those who were
counted of them, were fifty-three
thousand four hundred.
31 "All who were counted of the camp of
Dan were one hundred fifty-seven
thousand six hundred. They shall set out
last by their standards."
32 These are those who were counted of
the children of Israel by their fathers'
houses. All who were counted of the
camps according to their armies were six
hundred three thousand five hundred
fifty.
33 But the Levites were not counted
among the children of Israel, as Yahweh
commanded Moses.
34 Thus the children of Israel did.
According to all that Yahweh commanded
Moses, so they encamped by their
standards, and so they set out, everyone
by their families, according to their
fathers' houses.

3

1 Now this is the history of the
generations of Aaron and Moses in the
day that Yahweh spoke with Moses in
Mount Sinai.
2 These are the names of the sons of
Aaron: Nadab the firstborn, and Abihu,
Eleazar, and Ithamar.
3 These are the names of the sons of
Aaron, the priests who were anointed,
whom he consecrated to minister in the
priest's office.
4 Nadab and Abihu died before Yahweh
when they offered strange fire before
Yahweh in the wilderness of Sinai, and
they had no children. Eleazar and
Ithamar ministered in the priest's office in
the presence of Aaron their father.
5 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
6 "Bring the tribe of Levi near, and set
them before Aaron the priest, that they
may minister to him.
7 They shall keep his requirements, and
the requirements of the whole
congregation before the Tent of Meeting,
to do the service of the tabernacle.
8 They shall keep all the furnishings of
the Tent of Meeting, and the obligations of
the children of Israel, to do the service of
the tabernacle.
9 You shall give the Levites to Aaron and
to his sons. They are wholly given to him
on the behalf of the children of Israel.
10 You shall appoint Aaron and his sons,
and they shall keep their priesthood, but
the stranger who comes near shall be put
to death."
11 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
12 "Behold,† I have taken the Levites
from among the children of Israel instead
of all the firstborn who open the womb
among the children of Israel; and the
Levites shall be mine,
13 for all the firstborn are mine. On the
day that I struck down all the firstborn in
the land of Egypt I made holy to me all the
firstborn in Israel, both man and animal.
They shall be mine. I am Yahweh."
14 Yahweh spoke to Moses in the
wilderness of Sinai, saying,
15 "Count the children of Levi by their
fathers' houses, by their families. You
shall count every male from a month old
and upward."
16 Moses counted them according to
Yahweh's word, as he was commanded.
17 These were the sons of Levi by their
names: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.
18 These are the names of the sons of
Gershon by their families: Libni and
Shimei.
19 The sons of Kohath by their families:
Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel.
20 The sons of Merari by their families:
Mahli and Mushi.
These are the families of the Levites
according to their fathers' houses.
21 Of Gershon was the family of the
Libnites, and the family of the Shimeites.
These are the families of the Gershonites.
22 Those who were counted of them,
according to the number of all the males
from a month old and upward, even those

† **3:12** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

who were counted of them were seven thousand five hundred.
23 The families of the Gershonites shall encamp behind the tabernacle westward.
24 Eliasaph the son of Lael shall be the prince of the fathers' house of the Gershonites.
25 The duty of the sons of Gershon in the Tent of Meeting shall be the tabernacle, the tent, its covering, the screen for the door of the Tent of Meeting,
26 the hangings of the court, the screen for the door of the court which is by the tabernacle and around the altar, and its cords for all of its service.
27 Of Kohath was the family of the Amramites, the family of the Izharites, the family of the Hebronites, and the family of the Uzzielites. These are the families of the Kohathites.
28 According to the number of all the males from a month old and upward, there were eight thousand six hundred keeping the requirements of the sanctuary.
29 The families of the sons of Kohath shall encamp on the south side of the tabernacle.
30 The prince of the fathers' house of the families of the Kohathites shall be Elizaphan the son of Uzziel.
31 Their duty shall be the ark, the table, the lamp stand, the altars, the vessels of the sanctuary with which they minister, the screen, and all its service.
32 Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest shall be prince of the princes of the Levites, with the oversight of those who keep the requirements of the sanctuary.
33 Of Merari was the family of the Mahlites and the family of the Mushites. These are the families of Merari.
34 Those who were counted of them, according to the number of all the males from a month old and upward, were six thousand two hundred.‡
35 The prince of the fathers' house of the families of Merari was Zuriel the son of Abihail. They shall encamp on the north side of the tabernacle.
36 The appointed duty of the sons of Merari shall be the tabernacle's boards, its bars, its pillars, its sockets, all its instruments, all its service,
37 the pillars of the court around it, their sockets, their pins, and their cords.

38 Those who encamp before the tabernacle eastward, in front of the Tent of Meeting toward the sunrise, shall be Moses, with Aaron and his sons, keeping the requirements of the sanctuary for the duty of the children of Israel. The outsider who comes near shall be put to death.
39 All who were counted of the Levites, whom Moses and Aaron counted at the commandment of Yahweh, by their families, all the males from a month old and upward, were twenty-two thousand.

40 Yahweh said to Moses, "Count all the firstborn males of the children of Israel from a month old and upward, and take the number of their names.
41 You shall take the Levites for me—I am Yahweh—instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel; and the livestock of the Levites instead of all the firstborn among the livestock of the children of Israel."

42 Moses counted, as Yahweh commanded him, all the firstborn among the children of Israel.
43 All the firstborn males according to the number of names from a month old and upward, of those who were counted of them, were twenty-two thousand two hundred seventy-three.

44 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
45 "Take the Levites instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel, and the livestock of the Levites instead of their livestock; and the Levites shall be mine. I am Yahweh.
46 For the redemption of the two hundred seventy-three of the firstborn of the children of Israel who exceed the number of the Levites,

‡ **3:34** + 22,000 is the sum rounded to 2 significant digits. The sum of the Gershonites, Kohathites, and Merarites given above is 22,300, but the traditional Hebrew text has the number rounded to 2 significant digits, not 3 significant digits.
§ **3:47** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. † **3:47** A gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains.

47 you shall take five shekels apiece for
each one; according to the shekel§ of the
sanctuary you shall take them (the shekel
is twenty gerahs†);
48 and you shall give the money, with
which their remainder is redeemed, to
Aaron and to his sons."
49 Moses took the redemption money
from those who exceeded the number of
those who were redeemed by the Levites;
50 from the firstborn of the children of
Israel he took the money, one thousand
three hundred sixty-five shekels,‡
according to the shekel of the sanctuary;
51 and Moses gave the redemption
money to Aaron and to his sons, according
to Yahweh's word, as Yahweh
commanded Moses.

4

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
saying,
2 "Take a census of the sons of Kohath
from among the sons of Levi, by their
families, by their fathers' houses,
3 from thirty years old and upward even
until fifty years old, all who enter into the
service to do the work in the Tent of
Meeting.
4 "This is the service of the sons of
Kohath in the Tent of Meeting, regarding
the most holy things.
5 When the camp moves forward, Aaron
shall go in with his sons; and they shall
take down the veil of the screen, cover the
ark of the Testimony with it,
6 put a covering of sealskin on it, spread
a blue cloth over it, and put in its poles.
7 "On the table of show bread they shall
spread a blue cloth, and put on it the
dishes, the spoons, the bowls, and the
cups with which to pour out; and the
continual bread shall be on it.
8 They shall spread on them a scarlet
cloth, and cover it with a covering of
sealskin, and shall put in its poles.
9 "They shall take a blue cloth and cover
the lamp stand of the light, its lamps, its
snuffers, its snuff dishes, and all its oil
vessels, with which they minister to it.
10 They shall put it and all its vessels
within a covering of sealskin, and shall
put it on the frame.
11 "On the golden altar they shall spread
a blue cloth, and cover it with a covering
of sealskin, and shall put in its poles.
12 "They shall take all the vessels of
ministry with which they minister in the
sanctuary, and put them in a blue cloth,
cover them with a covering of sealskin,
and shall put them on the frame.
13 "They shall take away the ashes from
the altar, and spread a purple cloth on it.
14 They shall put on it all its vessels with
which they minister about it, the fire
pans, the meat hooks, the shovels, and the
basins—all the vessels of the altar; and
they shall spread on it a covering of
sealskin, and put in its poles.
15 "When Aaron and his sons have
finished covering the sanctuary and all
the furniture of the sanctuary, as the
camp moves forward; after that, the sons
of Kohath shall come to carry it; but they
shall not touch the sanctuary, lest they
die. The sons of Kohath shall carry these
things belonging to the Tent of Meeting.
16 "The duty of Eleazar the son of Aaron
the priest shall be the oil for the light, the
sweet incense, the continual meal
offering, and the anointing oil, the
requirements of all the tabernacle, and of
all that is in it, the sanctuary, and its
furnishings."
17 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
saying,
18 "Don't cut off the tribe of the families
of the Kohathites from among the Levites;
19 but do this to them, that they may
live, and not die, when they approach the
most holy things: Aaron and his sons shall
go in and appoint everyone to his service
and to his burden;
20 but they shall not go in to see the
sanctuary even for a moment, lest they
die."
21 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,

‡ **3:50** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1365 shekels is about 13.65 kilograms or about 30 pounds.

22 “Take a census of the sons of Gershon
also, by their fathers’ houses, by their
families;
23 you shall count them from thirty
years old and upward until fifty years old:
all who enter in to wait on the service, to
do the work in the Tent of Meeting.
24 “This is the service of the families of
the Gershonites, in serving and in bearing
burdens:
25 they shall carry the curtains of the
tabernacle and the Tent of Meeting, its
covering, the covering of sealskin that is
on it, the screen for the door of the Tent of
Meeting,
26 the hangings of the court, the screen
for the door of the gate of the court which
is by the tabernacle and around the altar,
their cords, and all the instruments of
their service, and whatever shall be done
with them. They shall serve in there.
27 At the commandment of Aaron and
his sons shall be all the service of the sons
of the Gershonites, in all their burden and
in all their service; and you shall appoint
their duty to them in all their
responsibilities.
28 This is the service of the families of
the sons of the Gershonites in the Tent of
Meeting. Their duty shall be under the
hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the
priest.
29 “As for the sons of Merari, you shall
count them by their families, by their
fathers’ houses;
30 you shall count them from thirty
years old and upward even to fifty years
old—everyone who enters on the service,
to do the work of the Tent of Meeting.
31 This is the duty of their burden,
according to all their service in the Tent of
Meeting: the tabernacle’s boards, its bars,
its pillars, its sockets,
32 the pillars of the court around it, their
sockets, their pins, their cords, with all
their instruments, and with all their
service. You shall appoint the instruments
of the duty of their burden to them by
name.
33 This is the service of the families of
the sons of Merari, according to all their
service in the Tent of Meeting, under the
hand of Ithamar the son of Aaron the
priest.”
34 Moses and Aaron and the princes of
the congregation counted the sons of the
Kohathites by their families, and by their
fathers’ houses,
35 from thirty years old and upward
even to fifty years old, everyone who
entered into the service for work in the
Tent of Meeting.
36 Those who were counted of them by
their families were two thousand seven
hundred fifty.
37 These are those who were counted of
the families of the Kohathites, all who
served in the Tent of Meeting, whom
Moses and Aaron counted according to
the commandment of Yahweh by Moses.
38 Those who were counted of the sons
of Gershon, by their families, and by their
fathers’ houses,
39 from thirty years old and upward
even to fifty years old—everyone who
entered into the service for work in the
Tent of Meeting,
40 even those who were counted of
them, by their families, by their fathers’
houses, were two thousand six hundred
thirty.
41 These are those who were counted of
the families of the sons of Gershon, all
who served in the Tent of Meeting, whom
Moses and Aaron counted according to
the commandment of Yahweh.
42 Those who were counted of the
families of the sons of Merari, by their
families, by their fathers’ houses,
43 from thirty years old and upward
even to fifty years old—everyone who
entered into the service for work in the
Tent of Meeting,
44 even those who were counted of them
by their families, were three thousand
two hundred.
45 These are those who were counted of
the families of the sons of Merari, whom
Moses and Aaron counted according to
the commandment of Yahweh by Moses.
46 All those who were counted of the
Levites whom Moses and Aaron and the
princes of Israel counted, by their families
and by their fathers’ houses,

47 from thirty years old and upward
even to fifty years old, everyone who
entered in to do the work of service and
the work of bearing burdens in the Tent of
Meeting,
48 even those who were counted of
them, were eight thousand five hundred
eighty.
49 According to the commandment of
Yahweh they were counted by Moses,
everyone according to his service and
according to his burden. Thus they were
counted by him, as Yahweh commanded
Moses.

5

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Command the children of Israel that
they put out of the camp every leper,
everyone who has a discharge, and
whoever is unclean by a corpse.
3 You shall put both male and female
outside of the camp so that they don't
defile their camp, in the midst of which I
dwell."
4 The children of Israel did so, and put
them outside of the camp; as Yahweh
spoke to Moses, so the children of Israel
did.
5 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
6 "Speak to the children of Israel: 'When
a man or woman commits any sin that
men commit, so as to trespass against
Yahweh, and that soul is guilty,
7 then he shall confess his sin which he
has done; and he shall make restitution
for his guilt in full, add to it the fifth part
of it, and give it to him in respect of whom
he has been guilty.
8 But if the man has no kinsman to
whom restitution may be made for the
guilt, the restitution for guilt which is
made to Yahweh shall be the priest's, in
addition to the ram of the atonement, by
which atonement shall be made for him.
9 Every heave offering of all the holy
things of the children of Israel, which they
present to the priest, shall be his.
10 Every man's holy things shall be his;
whatever any man gives the priest, it shall
be his.' "
11 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
12 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them: 'If any man's wife goes astray
and is unfaithful to him,
13 and a man lies with her carnally, and
it is hidden from the eyes of her husband
and this is kept concealed, and she is
defiled, there is no witness against her,
and she isn't taken in the act;
14 and the spirit of jealousy comes on
him, and he is jealous of his wife and she
is defiled; or if the spirit of jealousy comes
on him, and he is jealous of his wife and
she isn't defiled;
15 then the man shall bring his wife to
the priest, and shall bring her offering for
her: one tenth of an ephah† of barley
meal. He shall pour no oil on it, nor put
frankincense on it, for it is a meal offering
of jealousy, a meal offering of memorial,
bringing iniquity to memory.
16 The priest shall bring her near, and
set her before Yahweh.
17 The priest shall take holy water in an
earthen vessel; and the priest shall take
some of the dust that is on the floor of the
tabernacle and put it into the water.
18 The priest shall set the woman before
Yahweh, and let the hair of the woman's
head go loose, and put the meal offering
of memorial in her hands, which is the
meal offering of jealousy. The priest shall
have in his hand the water of bitterness
that brings a curse.
19 The priest shall cause her to take an
oath and shall tell the woman, "If no man
has lain with you, and if you haven't gone
aside to uncleanness, being under your
husband's authority, be free from this
water of bitterness that brings a curse.
20 But if you have gone astray, being
under your husband's authority, and if
you are defiled, and some man has lain
with you besides your husband—"
21 then the priest shall cause the woman
to swear with the oath of cursing, and the
priest shall tell the woman, "May Yahweh
make you a curse and an oath among your
people, when Yahweh allows your thigh
to fall away, and your body to swell;

† **5:15** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

22 and this water that brings a curse will
go into your bowels, and make your body
swell, and your thigh fall away." The
woman shall say, "Amen, Amen."
23 " 'The priest shall write these curses
in a book, and he shall wipe them into the
water of bitterness.
24 He shall make the woman drink the
water of bitterness that causes the curse;
and the water that causes the curse shall
enter into her and become bitter.
25 The priest shall take the meal offering
of jealousy out of the woman's hand, and
shall wave the meal offering before
Yahweh, and bring it to the altar.
26 The priest shall take a handful of the
meal offering, as its memorial portion,
and burn it on the altar, and afterward
shall make the woman drink the water.
27 When he has made her drink the
water, then it shall happen, if she is
defiled and has committed a trespass
against her husband, that the water that
causes the curse will enter into her and
become bitter, and her body will swell,
and her thigh will fall away; and the
woman will be a curse among her people.
28 If the woman isn't defiled, but is
clean; then she shall be free, and shall
conceive offspring.‡
29 " 'This is the law of jealousy, when a
wife, being under her husband, goes
astray, and is defiled,
30 or when the spirit of jealousy comes
on a man, and he is jealous of his wife;
then he shall set the woman before
Yahweh, and the priest shall execute on
her all this law.
31 The man shall be free from iniquity,
and that woman shall bear her iniquity.' "

6

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them: 'When either man or woman
shall make a special vow, the vow of a
Nazirite, to separate himself to Yahweh,
3 he shall separate himself from wine
and strong drink. He shall drink no
vinegar of wine, or vinegar of fermented
drink, neither shall he drink any juice of
grapes, nor eat fresh grapes or dried.
4 All the days of his separation he shall
eat nothing that is made of the grapevine,
from the seeds even to the skins.
5 " 'All the days of his vow of separation
no razor shall come on his head, until the
days are fulfilled in which he separates
himself to Yahweh. He shall be holy. He
shall let the locks of the hair of his head
grow long.
6 " 'All the days that he separates
himself to Yahweh he shall not go near a
dead body.
7 He shall not make himself unclean for
his father, or for his mother, for his
brother, or for his sister, when they die,
because his separation to God† is on his
head.
8 All the days of his separation he is holy
to Yahweh.
9 " 'If any man dies very suddenly
beside him, and he defiles the head of his
separation, then he shall shave his head in
the day of his cleansing. On the seventh
day he shall shave it.
10 On the eighth day he shall bring two
turtledoves or two young pigeons to the
priest, to the door of the Tent of Meeting.
11 The priest shall offer one for a sin
offering, and the other for a burnt
offering, and make atonement for him,
because he sinned by reason of the dead,
and shall make his head holy that same
day.
12 He shall separate to Yahweh the days
of his separation, and shall bring a male
lamb a year old for a trespass offering;
but the former days shall be void, because
his separation was defiled.
13 " 'This is the law of the Nazirite: when
the days of his separation are fulfilled, he
shall be brought to the door of the Tent of
Meeting,
14 and he shall offer his offering to
Yahweh: one male lamb a year old
without defect for a burnt offering, one
ewe lamb a year old without defect for a
sin offering, one ram without defect for
peace offerings,

‡ **5:28** or, seed † **6:7** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

15 a basket of unleavened bread, cakes
of fine flour mixed with oil, and
unleavened wafers anointed with oil with
their meal offering and their drink
offerings.
16 The priest shall present them before
Yahweh, and shall offer his sin offering
and his burnt offering.
17 He shall offer the ram for a sacrifice
of peace offerings to Yahweh, with the
basket of unleavened bread. The priest
shall offer also its meal offering and its
drink offering.
18 The Nazirite shall shave the head of
his separation at the door of the Tent of
Meeting, take the hair of the head of his
separation, and put it on the fire which is
under the sacrifice of peace offerings.
19 The priest shall take the boiled
shoulder of the ram, one unleavened cake
out of the basket, and one unleavened
wafer, and shall put them on the hands of
the Nazirite after he has shaved the head
of his separation;
20 and the priest shall wave them for a
wave offering before Yahweh. They are
holy for the priest, together with the
breast that is waved and the thigh that is
offered. After that the Nazirite may drink
wine.
21 " 'This is the law of the Nazirite who
vows and of his offering to Yahweh for his
separation, in addition to that which he is
able to afford. According to his vow which
he vows, so he must do after the law of his
separation.' "

22 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
23 "Speak to Aaron and to his sons,
saying, 'This is how you shall bless the
children of Israel.' You shall tell them,

24 'Yahweh bless you, and keep you.
25 Yahweh make his face to shine on
you,
and be gracious to you.

26 Yahweh lift up his face toward you,
and give you peace.'

27 "So they shall put my name on the
children of Israel; and I will bless them."

7

1 On the day that Moses had finished
setting up the tabernacle, and had
anointed it and sanctified it with all its
furniture, and the altar with all its vessels,
and had anointed and sanctified them;
2 the princes of Israel, the heads of their
fathers' houses, gave offerings. These
were the princes of the tribes. These are
they who were over those who were
counted;
3 and they brought their offering before
Yahweh, six covered wagons and twelve
oxen; a wagon for every two of the
princes, and for each one an ox. They
presented them before the tabernacle.
4 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
5 "Accept these from them, that they
may be used in doing the service of the
Tent of Meeting; and you shall give them
to the Levites, to every man according to
his service."
6 Moses took the wagons and the oxen,
and gave them to the Levites.
7 He gave two wagons and four oxen to
the sons of Gershon, according to their
service.
8 He gave four wagons and eight oxen to
the sons of Merari, according to their
service, under the direction of Ithamar
the son of Aaron the priest.
9 But to the sons of Kohath he gave
none, because the service of the sanctuary
belonged to them; they carried it on their
shoulders.
10 The princes gave offerings for the
dedication of the altar in the day that it
was anointed. The princes gave their
offerings before the altar.
11 Yahweh said to Moses, "They shall
offer their offering, each prince on his
day, for the dedication of the altar."
12 He who offered his offering the first
day was Nahshon the son of Amminadab,
of the tribe of Judah,
13 and his offering was:
one silver platter, the weight of which
was one hundred thirty shekels,†
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,

† **7:13** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
14 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
15 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
16 one male goat for a sin offering;
17 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, and five male lambs a
year old. This was the offering of
Nahshon the son of Amminadab.
18 On the second day Nethanel the son of
Zuar, prince of Issachar, gave his offering.
19 He offered for his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which
was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,
both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
20 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
21 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
22 one male goat for a sin offering;
23 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, five male lambs a year
old. This was the offering of Nethanel the
son of Zuar.
24 On the third day Eliab the son of
Helon, prince of the children of Zebulun,
25 gave his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which
was a hundred and thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,
both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
26 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
27 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
28 one male goat for a sin offering;
29 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, and five male lambs a
year old. This was the offering of Eliab the
son of Helon.
30 On the fourth day Elizur the son of
Shedeur, prince of the children of Reuben,
31 gave his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which
was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,
both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
32 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
33 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
34 one male goat for a sin offering;
35 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, and five male lambs a
year old. This was the offering of Elizur
the son of Shedeur.
36 On the fifth day Shelumiel the son of
Zurishaddai, prince of the children of
Simeon,
37 gave his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which
was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,
both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
38 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
39 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
40 one male goat for a sin offering;
41 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, and five male lambs a
year old: this was the offering of
Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai.
42 On the sixth day, Eliasaph the son of
Deuel, prince of the children of Gad,
43 gave his offering:

one silver platter, the weight of which
was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,
both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
44 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
45 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
46 one male goat for a sin offering;
47 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, and five male lambs a
year old. This was the offering of Eliasaph
the son of Deuel.
48 On the seventh day Elishama the son
of Ammihud, prince of the children of
Ephraim,
49 gave his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which
was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,
both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
50 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
51 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
52 one male goat for a sin offering;
53 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, and five male lambs a
year old. This was the offering of
Elishama the son of Ammihud.
54 On the eighth day Gamaliel the son of
Pedahzur, prince of the children of
Manasseh,
55 gave his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which
was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,
both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
56 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
57 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
58 one male goat for a sin offering;
59 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, and five male lambs a
year old. This was the offering of Gamaliel
the son of Pedahzur.
60 On the ninth day Abidan the son of
Gideoni, prince of the children of
Benjamin,
61 gave his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which
was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,
both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
62 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
63 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
64 one male goat for a sin offering;
65 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, and five male lambs a
year old. This was the offering of Abidan
the son of Gideoni.
66 On the tenth day Ahiezer the son of
Ammishaddai, prince of the children of
Dan,
67 gave his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which
was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels,
according to the shekel of the sanctuary,
both of them full of fine flour mixed with
oil for a meal offering;
68 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of
incense;
69 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt
offering;
70 one male goat for a sin offering;
71 and for the sacrifice of peace
offerings, two head of cattle, five rams,
five male goats, and five male lambs a

year old. This was the offering of Ahiezer the son of Ammishaddai.
72 On the eleventh day Pagiel the son of Ochran, prince of the children of Asher,
73 gave his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering;
74 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense;
75 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
76 one male goat for a sin offering;
77 and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Pagiel the son of Ochran.
78 On the twelfth day Ahira the son of Enan, prince of the children of Naphtali,
79 gave his offering:
one silver platter, the weight of which was one hundred thirty shekels,
one silver bowl of seventy shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary, both of them full of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering;
80 one golden ladle of ten shekels, full of incense;
81 one young bull,
one ram,
one male lamb a year old, for a burnt offering;
82 one male goat for a sin offering;
83 and for the sacrifice of peace offerings, two head of cattle, five rams, five male goats, and five male lambs a year old. This was the offering of Ahira the son of Enan.
84 This was the dedication offering of the altar, on the day when it was anointed, by the princes of Israel: twelve silver platters, twelve silver bowls, twelve golden ladles;
85 each silver platter weighing one hundred thirty shekels, and each bowl seventy; all the silver of the vessels two thousand four hundred shekels, according to the shekel of the sanctuary;
86 the twelve golden ladles, full of incense, weighing ten shekels apiece, according to the shekel of the sanctuary; all the gold of the ladles weighed one hundred twenty shekels;
87 all the cattle for the burnt offering twelve bulls, the rams twelve, the male lambs a year old twelve, and their meal offering; and twelve male goats for a sin offering;
88 and all the cattle for the sacrifice of peace offerings: twenty-four bulls, sixty rams, sixty male goats, and sixty male lambs a year old. This was the dedication offering of the altar, after it was anointed.
89 When Moses went into the Tent of Meeting to speak with Yahweh, he heard his voice speaking to him from above the mercy seat that was on the ark of the Testimony, from between the two cherubim; and he spoke to him.

8

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 “Speak to Aaron, and tell him, ‘When you light the lamps, the seven lamps shall give light in front of the lamp stand.’ ”
3 Aaron did so. He lit its lamps to light the area in front of the lamp stand, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
4 This was the workmanship of the lamp stand, beaten work of gold. From its base to its flowers, it was beaten work. He made the lamp stand according to the pattern which Yahweh had shown Moses.
5 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
6 “Take the Levites from among the children of Israel, and cleanse them.
7 You shall do this to them to cleanse them: sprinkle the water of cleansing on them, let them shave their whole bodies with a razor, let them wash their clothes, and cleanse themselves.
8 Then let them take a young bull and its meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil; and another young bull you shall take for a sin offering.
9 You shall present the Levites before the Tent of Meeting. You shall assemble

the whole congregation of the children of Israel.
10 You shall present the Levites before Yahweh. The children of Israel shall lay their hands on the Levites,
11 and Aaron shall offer the Levites before Yahweh for a wave offering on the behalf of the children of Israel, that it may be theirs to do the service of Yahweh.
12 "The Levites shall lay their hands on the heads of the bulls, and you shall offer the one for a sin offering and the other for a burnt offering to Yahweh, to make atonement for the Levites.
13 You shall set the Levites before Aaron and before his sons, and offer them as a wave offering to Yahweh.
14 Thus you shall separate the Levites from among the children of Israel, and the Levites shall be mine.
15 "After that, the Levites shall go in to do the service of the Tent of Meeting. You shall cleanse them, and offer them as a wave offering.
16 For they are wholly given to me from among the children of Israel; instead of all who open the womb, even the firstborn of all the children of Israel, I have taken them to me.
17 For all the firstborn among the children of Israel are mine, both man and animal. On the day that I struck all the firstborn in the land of Egypt, I sanctified them for myself.
18 I have taken the Levites instead of all the firstborn among the children of Israel.
19 I have given the Levites as a gift to Aaron and to his sons from among the children of Israel, to do the service of the children of Israel in the Tent of Meeting, and to make atonement for the children of Israel, so that there will be no plague among the children of Israel when the children of Israel come near to the sanctuary."
20 Moses, and Aaron, and all the congregation of the children of Israel did so to the Levites. According to all that Yahweh commanded Moses concerning the Levites, so the children of Israel did to them.
21 The Levites purified themselves from sin, and they washed their clothes; and Aaron offered them for a wave offering before Yahweh and Aaron made atonement for them to cleanse them.
22 After that, the Levites went in to do their service in the Tent of Meeting before Aaron and before his sons: as Yahweh had commanded Moses concerning the Levites, so they did to them.
23 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
24 "This is what is assigned to the Levites: from twenty-five years old and upward they shall go in to wait on the service in the work of the Tent of Meeting;
25 and from the age of fifty years they shall retire from doing the work, and shall serve no more,
26 but shall assist their brothers in the Tent of Meeting, to perform the duty, and shall perform no service. This is how you shall have the Levites do their duties."

9

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses in the wilderness of Sinai, in the first month of the second year after they had come out of the land of Egypt, saying,
2 "Let the children of Israel keep the Passover in its appointed season.
3 On the fourteenth day of this month, at evening, you shall keep it in its appointed season. You shall keep it according to all its statutes and according to all its ordinances."
4 Moses told the children of Israel that they should keep the Passover.
5 They kept the Passover in the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month at evening, in the wilderness of Sinai. According to all that Yahweh commanded Moses, so the children of Israel did.
6 There were certain men who were unclean because of the dead body of a man, so that they could not keep the Passover on that day, and they came before Moses and Aaron on that day.
7 Those men said to him, "We are unclean because of the dead body of a man. Why are we kept back, that we may not offer the offering of Yahweh in its appointed season among the children of Israel?"

8 Moses answered them, “Wait, that I
may hear what Yahweh will command
concerning you.”

9 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
10 “Say to the children of Israel, ‘If any
man of you or of your generations is
unclean by reason of a dead body, or is on
a journey far away, he shall still keep the
Passover to Yahweh.
11 In the second month, on the
fourteenth day at evening they shall keep
it; they shall eat it with unleavened bread
and bitter herbs.
12 They shall leave none of it until the
morning, nor break a bone of it.
According to all the statute of the Passover
they shall keep it.
13 But the man who is clean, and is not
on a journey, and fails to keep the
Passover, that soul shall be cut off from
his people. Because he didn’t offer the
offering of Yahweh in its appointed
season, that man shall bear his sin.

14 “ ‘If a foreigner lives among you and
desires to keep the Passover to Yahweh,
then he shall do so according to the
statute of the Passover, and according to
its ordinance. You shall have one statute,
both for the foreigner and for him who is
born in the land.’ ”

15 On the day that the tabernacle was
raised up, the cloud covered the
tabernacle, even the Tent of the
Testimony. At evening it was over the
tabernacle, as it were the appearance of
fire, until morning.
16 So it was continually. The cloud
covered it, and the appearance of fire by
night.
17 Whenever the cloud was taken up
from over the Tent, then after that the
children of Israel traveled; and in the
place where the cloud remained, there
the children of Israel encamped.
18 At the commandment of Yahweh, the
children of Israel traveled, and at the
commandment of Yahweh they
encamped. As long as the cloud remained
on the tabernacle they remained
encamped.
19 When the cloud stayed on the
tabernacle many days, then the children
of Israel kept Yahweh’s command, and
didn’t travel.
20 Sometimes the cloud was a few days
on the tabernacle; then according to the
commandment of Yahweh they remained
encamped, and according to the
commandment of Yahweh they traveled.
21 Sometimes the cloud was from
evening until morning; and when the
cloud was taken up in the morning, they
traveled; or by day and by night, when the
cloud was taken up, they traveled.
22 Whether it was two days, or a month,
or a year that the cloud stayed on the
tabernacle, remaining on it, the children
of Israel remained encamped, and didn’t
travel; but when it was taken up, they
traveled.
23 At the commandment of Yahweh they
encamped, and at the commandment of
Yahweh they traveled. They kept
Yahweh’s command, at the
commandment of Yahweh by Moses.

10

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 “Make two trumpets of silver. You
shall make them of beaten work. You shall
use them for the calling of the
congregation and for the journeying of
the camps.
3 When they blow them, all the
congregation shall gather themselves to
you at the door of the Tent of Meeting.
4 If they blow just one, then the princes,
the heads of the thousands of Israel, shall
gather themselves to you.
5 When you blow an alarm, the camps
that lie on the east side shall go forward.
6 When you blow an alarm the second
time, the camps that lie on the south side
shall go forward. They shall blow an
alarm for their journeys.
7 But when the assembly is to be
gathered together, you shall blow, but you
shall not sound an alarm.
8 “The sons of Aaron, the priests, shall
blow the trumpets. This shall be to you for

a statute forever throughout your
generations.
9 When you go to war in your land
against the adversary who oppresses you,
then you shall sound an alarm with the
trumpets. Then you will be remembered
before Yahweh your God, and you will be
saved from your enemies.

10 “Also in the day of your gladness, and
in your set feasts, and in the beginnings of
your months, you shall blow the trumpets
over your burnt offerings, and over the
sacrifices of your peace offerings; and
they shall be to you for a memorial before
your God. I am Yahweh your God.”

11 In the second year, in the second
month, on the twentieth day of the month,
the cloud was taken up from over the
tabernacle of the covenant.
12 The children of Israel went forward
on their journeys out of the wilderness of
Sinai; and the cloud stayed in the
wilderness of Paran.
13 They first went forward according to
the commandment of Yahweh by Moses.

14 First, the standard of the camp of the
children of Judah went forward according
to their armies. Nahshon the son of
Amminadab was over his army.
15 Nethanel the son of Zuar was over the
army of the tribe of the children of
Issachar.
16 Eliab the son of Helon was over the
army of the tribe of the children of
Zebulun.
17 The tabernacle was taken down; and
the sons of Gershon and the sons of
Merari, who bore the tabernacle, went
forward.
18 The standard of the camp of Reuben
went forward according to their armies.
Elizur the son of Shedeur was over his
army.
19 Shelumiel the son of Zurishaddai was
over the army of the tribe of the children
of Simeon.
20 Eliasaph the son of Deuel was over the
army of the tribe of the children of Gad.

21 The Kohathites set forward, bearing
the sanctuary. The others set up the
tabernacle before they arrived.

22 The standard of the camp of the
children of Ephraim set forward
according to their armies. Elishama the
son of Ammihud was over his army.
23 Gamaliel the son of Pedahzur was
over the army of the tribe of the children
of Manasseh.
24 Abidan the son of Gideoni was over
the army of the tribe of the children of
Benjamin.
25 The standard of the camp of the
children of Dan, which was the rear guard
of all the camps, set forward according to
their armies. Ahiezer the son of
Ammishaddai was over his army.
26 Pagiel the son of Ochran was over the
army of the tribe of the children of Asher.
27 Ahira the son of Enan was over the
army of the tribe of the children of
Naphtali.
28 Thus were the travels of the children
of Israel according to their armies; and
they went forward.

29 Moses said to Hobab, the son of Reuel
the Midianite, Moses’ father-in-law, “We
are journeying to the place of which
Yahweh said, ‘I will give it to you.’ Come
with us, and we will treat you well; for
Yahweh has spoken good concerning
Israel.”
30 He said to him, “I will not go; but I will
depart to my own land, and to my
relatives.”
31 Moses said, “Don’t leave us, please;
because you know how we are to encamp
in the wilderness, and you can be our
eyes.
32 It shall be, if you go with us—yes, it
shall be—that whatever good Yahweh
does to us, we will do the same to you.”

33 They set forward from the Mount of
Yahweh three days’ journey. The ark of
Yahweh’s covenant went before them
three days’ journey, to seek out a resting
place for them.
34 The cloud of Yahweh was over them
by day, when they set forward from the
camp.
35 When the ark went forward, Moses
said, “Rise up, Yahweh, and let your
enemies be scattered! Let those who hate
you flee before you!”

36 When it rested, he said, “Return,
Yahweh, to the ten thousands of the
thousands of Israel.”

11

1 The people were complaining in the
ears of Yahweh. When Yahweh heard it,
his anger burned; and Yahweh’s fire
burned among them, and consumed some
of the outskirts of the camp.
2 The people cried to Moses; and Moses
prayed to Yahweh, and the fire abated.
3 The name of that place was called
Taberah,† because Yahweh’s fire burned
among them.
4 The mixed multitude that was among
them lusted exceedingly; and the children
of Israel also wept again, and said, “Who
will give us meat to eat?
5 We remember the fish, which we ate
in Egypt for nothing; the cucumbers, and
the melons, and the leeks, and the onions,
and the garlic;
6 but now we have lost our appetite.
There is nothing at all except this manna
to look at.”
7 The manna was like coriander seed,
and it looked like bdellium.‡
8 The people went around, gathered it,
and ground it in mills, or beat it in
mortars, and boiled it in pots, and made
cakes of it. Its taste was like the taste of
fresh oil.
9 When the dew fell on the camp in the
night, the manna fell on it.
10 Moses heard the people weeping
throughout their families, every man at
the door of his tent; and Yahweh’s anger
burned greatly; and Moses was
displeased.
11 Moses said to Yahweh, “Why have
you treated your servant so badly? Why
haven’t I found favor in your sight, that
you lay the burden of all this people on
me?
12 Have I conceived all this people?
Have I brought them out, that you should
tell me, ‘Carry them in your bosom, as a
nurse carries a nursing infant, to the land
which you swore to their fathers’?
13 Where could I get meat to give all
these people? For they weep before me,
saying, ‘Give us meat, that we may eat.’
14 I am not able to bear all this people
alone, because it is too heavy for me.
15 If you treat me this way, please kill
me right now, if I have found favor in
your sight; and don’t let me see my
wretchedness.”
16 Yahweh said to Moses, “Gather to me
seventy men of the elders of Israel, whom
you know to be the elders of the people
and officers over them; and bring them to
the Tent of Meeting, that they may stand
there with you.
17 I will come down and talk with you
there. I will take of the Spirit which is on
you, and will put it on them; and they
shall bear the burden of the people with
you, that you don’t bear it yourself alone.
18 “Say to the people, ‘Sanctify
yourselves in preparation for tomorrow,
and you will eat meat; for you have wept
in the ears of Yahweh, saying, “Who will
give us meat to eat? For it was well with
us in Egypt.” Therefore Yahweh will give
you meat, and you will eat.
19 You will not eat just one day, or two
days, or five days, or ten days, or twenty
days,
20 but a whole month, until it comes out
at your nostrils, and it is loathsome to you;
because you have rejected Yahweh who is
among you, and have wept before him,
saying, “Why did we come out of
Egypt?” ’ ”
21 Moses said, “The people, among
whom I am, are six hundred thousand
men on foot; and you have said, ‘I will give
them meat, that they may eat a whole
month.’
22 Shall flocks and herds be slaughtered
for them, to be sufficient for them? Shall
all the fish of the sea be gathered together
for them, to be sufficient for them?”
23 Yahweh said to Moses, “Has Yahweh’s
hand grown short? Now you will see
whether my word will happen to you or
not.”

† **11:3** Taberah means “burning” ‡ **11:7** Bdellium is a resin extracted from certain African trees.

24 Moses went out, and told the people
Yahweh's words; and he gathered seventy
men of the elders of the people, and set
them around the Tent.
25 Yahweh came down in the cloud, and
spoke to him, and took of the Spirit that
was on him, and put it on the seventy
elders. When the Spirit rested on them,
they prophesied, but they did so no more.
26 But two men remained in the camp.
The name of one was Eldad, and the name
of the other Medad; and the Spirit rested
on them. They were of those who were
written, but had not gone out to the Tent;
and they prophesied in the camp.
27 A young man ran, and told Moses,
and said, "Eldad and Medad are
prophesying in the camp!"

28 Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of
Moses, one of his chosen men, answered,
"My lord Moses, forbid them!"

29 Moses said to him, "Are you jealous
for my sake? I wish that all Yahweh's
people were prophets, that Yahweh would
put his Spirit on them!"

30 Moses went into the camp, he and the
elders of Israel.
31 A wind from Yahweh went out and
brought quails from the sea, and let them
fall by the camp, about a day's journey on
this side, and a day's journey on the other
side, around the camp, and about two
cubits§ above the surface of the earth.
32 The people rose up all that day, and
all of that night, and all the next day, and
gathered the quails. He who gathered
least gathered ten homers;† and they
spread them all out for themselves
around the camp.
33 While the meat was still between
their teeth, before it was chewed,
Yahweh's anger burned against the
people, and Yahweh struck the people
with a very great plague.
34 The name of that place was called
Kibroth Hattaavah,‡ because there they
buried the people who lusted.

35 From Kibroth Hattaavah the people
traveled to Hazeroth; and they stayed at
Hazeroth.

12

1 Miriam and Aaron spoke against
Moses because of the Cushite woman
whom he had married; for he had
married a Cushite woman.
2 They said, "Has Yahweh indeed spoken
only with Moses? Hasn't he spoken also
with us?" And Yahweh heard it.
3 Now the man Moses was very humble,
more than all the men who were on the
surface of the earth.
4 Yahweh spoke suddenly to Moses, to
Aaron, and to Miriam, "You three come
out to the Tent of Meeting!"

The three of them came out.
5 Yahweh came down in a pillar of
cloud, and stood at the door of the Tent,
and called Aaron and Miriam; and they
both came forward.
6 He said, "Now hear my words. If there
is a prophet among you, I, Yahweh, will
make myself known to him in a vision. I
will speak with him in a dream.
7 My servant Moses is not so. He is
faithful in all my house.
8 With him, I will speak mouth to
mouth, even plainly, and not in riddles;
and he shall see Yahweh's form. Why then
were you not afraid to speak against my
servant, against Moses?"
9 Yahweh's anger burned against them;
and he departed.

10 The cloud departed from over the
Tent; and behold, Miriam was leprous, as
white as snow. Aaron looked at Miriam,
and behold, she was leprous.

11 Aaron said to Moses, "Oh, my lord,
please don't count this sin against us, in
which we have done foolishly, and in
which we have sinned.
12 Let her not, I pray, be as one dead, of
whom the flesh is half consumed when he
comes out of his mother's womb."
13 Moses cried to Yahweh, saying, "Heal
her, God, I beg you!"

§ **11:31** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. † **11:32** 1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels ‡ **11:34** Kibroth Hattaavah means "graves of lust"

14 Yahweh said to Moses, “If her father
had but spit in her face, shouldn’t she be
ashamed seven days? Let her be shut up
outside of the camp seven days, and after
that she shall be brought in again.”
15 Miriam was shut up outside of the
camp seven days, and the people didn’t
travel until Miriam was brought in again.
16 Afterward the people traveled from
Hazeroth, and encamped in the
wilderness of Paran.

13

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 “Send men, that they may spy out the
land of Canaan, which I give to the
children of Israel. Of every tribe of their
fathers, you shall send a man, every one a
prince among them.”
3 Moses sent them from the wilderness
of Paran according to the commandment
of Yahweh. All of them were men who
were heads of the children of Israel.
4 These were their names:
Of the tribe of Reuben, Shammua the son
of Zaccur.
5 Of the tribe of Simeon, Shaphat the son
of Hori.
6 Of the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of
Jephunneh.
7 Of the tribe of Issachar, Igal the son of
Joseph.
8 Of the tribe of Ephraim, Hoshea the son
of Nun.
9 Of the tribe of Benjamin, Palti the son of
Raphu.
10 Of the tribe of Zebulun, Gaddiel the son
of Sodi.
11 Of the tribe of Joseph, of the tribe of
Manasseh, Gaddi the son of Susi.
12 Of the tribe of Dan, Ammiel the son of
Gemalli.
13 Of the tribe of Asher, Sethur the son of
Michael.
14 Of the tribe of Naphtali, Nahbi the son
of Vophsi.
15 Of the tribe of Gad, Geuel the son of
Machi.
16 These are the names of the men who
Moses sent to spy out the land. Moses
called Hoshea the son of Nun Joshua.
17 Moses sent them to spy out the land of
Canaan, and said to them, “Go up this way
by the South, and go up into the hill
country.
18 See the land, what it is; and the people
who dwell therein, whether they are
strong or weak, whether they are few or
many;
19 and what the land is that they dwell in,
whether it is good or bad; and what cities
they are that they dwell in, whether in
camps, or in strongholds;
20 and what the land is, whether it is
fertile or poor, whether there is wood
therein, or not. Be courageous, and bring
some of the fruit of the land.” Now the
time was the time of the first-ripe grapes.

21 So they went up, and spied out the
land from the wilderness of Zin to Rehob,
to the entrance of Hamath.
22 They went up by the South, and came
to Hebron; and Ahiman, Sheshai, and
Talmai, the children of Anak, were there.
(Now Hebron was built seven years
before Zoan in Egypt.)
23 They came to the valley of Eshcol, and
cut down from there a branch with one
cluster of grapes, and they bore it on a
staff between two. They also brought
some of the pomegranates and figs.
24 That place was called the valley of
Eshcol, because of the cluster which the
children of Israel cut down from there.
25 They returned from spying out the
land at the end of forty days.
26 They went and came to Moses, to
Aaron, and to all the congregation of the
children of Israel, to the wilderness of
Paran, to Kadesh; and brought back word
to them and to all the congregation. They
showed them the fruit of the land.
27 They told him, and said, “We came to
the land where you sent us. Surely it flows
with milk and honey, and this is its fruit.
28 However, the people who dwell in the
land are strong, and the cities are fortified
and very large. Moreover, we saw the
children of Anak there.
29 Amalek dwells in the land of the
South. The Hittite, the Jebusite, and the
Amorite dwell in the hill country. The
Canaanite dwells by the sea, and along the
side of the Jordan.”

30 Caleb stilled the people before Moses,
and said, “Let’s go up at once, and possess
it; for we are well able to overcome it!”
31 But the men who went up with him
said, “We aren’t able to go up against the
people; for they are stronger than we.”
32 They brought up an evil report of the
land which they had spied out to the
children of Israel, saying, “The land,
through which we have gone to spy it out,
is a land that eats up its inhabitants; and
all the people who we saw in it are men of
great stature.
33 There we saw the Nephilim,† the sons
of Anak, who come from the Nephilim.‡
We were in our own sight as
grasshoppers, and so we were in their
sight.”

14

1 All the congregation lifted up their
voice, and cried; and the people wept that
night.
2 All the children of Israel murmured
against Moses and against Aaron. The
whole congregation said to them, “We
wish that we had died in the land of Egypt,
or that we had died in this wilderness!
3 Why does Yahweh bring us to this
land, to fall by the sword? Our wives and
our little ones will be captured or killed!
Wouldn’t it be better for us to return into
Egypt?”
4 They said to one another, “Let’s choose
a leader, and let’s return into Egypt.”
5 Then Moses and Aaron fell on their
faces before all the assembly of the
congregation of the children of Israel.
6 Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb the
son of Jephunneh, who were of those who
spied out the land, tore their clothes.
7 They spoke to all the congregation of
the children of Israel, saying, “The land,
which we passed through to spy it out, is
an exceedingly good land.
8 If Yahweh delights in us, then he will
bring us into this land, and give it to us: a
land which flows with milk and honey.
9 Only don’t rebel against Yahweh,
neither fear the people of the land; for
they are bread for us. Their defense is
removed from over them, and Yahweh is
with us. Don’t fear them.”
10 But all the congregation threatened to
stone them with stones.

Yahweh’s glory appeared in the Tent of
Meeting to all the children of Israel.
11 Yahweh said to Moses, “How long will
this people despise me? How long will
they not believe in me, for all the signs
which I have worked among them?
12 I will strike them with the pestilence,
and disinherit them, and will make of you
a nation greater and mightier than they.”

13 Moses said to Yahweh, “Then the
Egyptians will hear it; for you brought up
this people in your might from among
them.
14 They will tell it to the inhabitants of
this land. They have heard that you
Yahweh are among this people; for you
Yahweh are seen face to face, and your
cloud stands over them, and you go before
them, in a pillar of cloud by day, and in a
pillar of fire by night.
15 Now if you killed this people as one
man, then the nations which have heard
the fame of you will speak, saying,
16 ‘Because Yahweh was not able to
bring this people into the land which he
swore to them, therefore he has slain
them in the wilderness.’
17 Now please let the power of the Lord†
be great, according as you have spoken,
saying,
18 ‘Yahweh is slow to anger, and
abundant in loving kindness, forgiving
iniquity and disobedience; and he will by
no means clear the guilty, visiting the
iniquity of the fathers on the children, on
the third and on the fourth generation.’
19 Please pardon the iniquity of this
people according to the greatness of your
loving kindness, and just as you have
forgiven this people, from Egypt even
until now.”
20 Yahweh said, “I have pardoned
according to your word;

† **13:33** or, giants ‡ **13:33** or, giants † **14:17** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai.”

21 but in very deed—as I live, and as all
the earth shall be filled with Yahweh's
glory—
22 because all those men who have seen
my glory and my signs, which I worked in
Egypt and in the wilderness, yet have
tempted me these ten times, and have not
listened to my voice;
23 surely they shall not see the land
which I swore to their fathers, neither
shall any of those who despised me see it.
24 But my servant Caleb, because he had
another spirit with him, and has followed
me fully, him I will bring into the land
into which he went. His offspring shall
possess it.
25 Since the Amalekite and the
Canaanite dwell in the valley, tomorrow
turn and go into the wilderness by the
way to the Red Sea."
26 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
saying,
27 "How long shall I bear with this evil
congregation that complain against me? I
have heard the complaints of the children
of Israel, which they complain against me.
28 Tell them, 'As I live, says Yahweh,
surely as you have spoken in my ears, so I
will do to you.
29 Your dead bodies shall fall in this
wilderness; and all who were counted of
you, according to your whole number,
from twenty years old and upward, who
have complained against me,
30 surely you shall not come into the
land concerning which I swore that I
would make you dwell therein, except
Caleb the son of Jephunneh, and Joshua
the son of Nun.
31 But I will bring in your little ones that
you said should be captured or killed, and
they shall know the land which you have
rejected.
32 But as for you, your dead bodies shall
fall in this wilderness.
33 Your children shall be wanderers in
the wilderness forty years, and shall bear
your prostitution, until your dead bodies
are consumed in the wilderness.
34 After the number of the days in which
you spied out the land, even forty days,
for every day a year, you will bear your
iniquities, even forty years, and you will
know my alienation.'
35 I, Yahweh, have spoken. I will surely
do this to all this evil congregation who
are gathered together against me. In this
wilderness they shall be consumed, and
there they shall die."
36 The men whom Moses sent to spy out
the land, who returned and made all the
congregation to murmur against him by
bringing up an evil report against the
land,
37 even those men who brought up an
evil report of the land, died by the plague
before Yahweh.
38 But Joshua the son of Nun and Caleb
the son of Jephunneh remained alive of
those men who went to spy out the land.
39 Moses told these words to all the
children of Israel, and the people
mourned greatly.
40 They rose up early in the morning
and went up to the top of the mountain,
saying, "Behold, we are here, and will go
up to the place which Yahweh has
promised; for we have sinned."
41 Moses said, "Why now do you disobey
the commandment of Yahweh, since it
shall not prosper?
42 Don't go up, for Yahweh isn't among
you; that way you won't be struck down
before your enemies.
43 For there the Amalekite and the
Canaanite are before you, and you will
fall by the sword because you turned back
from following Yahweh; therefore
Yahweh will not be with you."
44 But they presumed to go up to the top
of the mountain. Nevertheless, the ark of
Yahweh's covenant and Moses didn't
depart out of the camp.
45 Then the Amalekites came down, and
the Canaanites who lived in that
mountain, and struck them and beat them
down even to Hormah.

15

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them, 'When you have come into the
land of your habitations, which I give to
you,

3 and will make an offering by fire to
Yahweh—a burnt offering, or a sacrifice,
to accomplish a vow, or as a free will
offering, or in your set feasts, to make a
pleasant aroma to Yahweh, of the herd, or
of the flock—
4 then he who offers his offering shall
offer to Yahweh a meal offering of one
tenth of an ephah† of fine flour mixed
with one fourth of a hin‡ of oil.
5 You shall prepare wine for the drink
offering, one fourth of a hin, with the
burnt offering or for the sacrifice, for each
lamb.
6 " 'For a ram, you shall prepare for a
meal offering two tenths of an ephah§ of
fine flour mixed with the third part of a
hin of oil;
7 and for the drink offering you shall
offer the third part of a hin of wine, of a
pleasant aroma to Yahweh.
8 When you prepare a bull for a burnt
offering or for a sacrifice, to accomplish a
vow, or for peace offerings to Yahweh,
9 then he shall offer with the bull a meal
offering of three tenths of an ephah† of
fine flour mixed with half a hin of oil;
10 and you shall offer for the drink
offering half a hin of wine, for an offering
made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to
Yahweh.
11 Thus it shall be done for each bull, for
each ram, for each of the male lambs, or
of the young goats.
12 According to the number that you
shall prepare, so you shall do to everyone
according to their number.
13 " 'All who are native-born shall do
these things in this way, in offering an
offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma
to Yahweh.
14 If a stranger lives as a foreigner with
you, or whoever may be among you
throughout your generations, and will
offer an offering made by fire, of a
pleasant aroma to Yahweh, as you do, so
he shall do.
15 For the assembly, there shall be one
statute for you and for the stranger who
lives as a foreigner, a statute forever
throughout your generations. As you are,
so the foreigner shall be before Yahweh.
16 One law and one ordinance shall be
for you and for the stranger who lives as a
foreigner with you.' "

17 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
18 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them, 'When you come into the land
where I bring you,
19 then it shall be that when you eat of
the bread of the land, you shall offer up a
wave offering to Yahweh.
20 Of the first of your dough you shall
offer up a cake for a wave offering. As the
wave offering of the threshing floor, so
you shall heave it.
21 Of the first of your dough, you shall
give to Yahweh a wave offering
throughout your generations.

22 " 'When you err, and don't observe all
these commandments which Yahweh has
spoken to Moses—
23 even all that Yahweh has commanded
you by Moses, from the day that Yahweh
gave commandment and onward
throughout your generations—
24 then it shall be, if it was done
unwittingly, without the knowledge of the
congregation, that all the congregation
shall offer one young bull for a burnt
offering, for a pleasant aroma to Yahweh,
with its meal offering and its drink
offering, according to the ordinance, and
one male goat for a sin offering.
25 The priest shall make atonement for
all the congregation of the children of
Israel, and they shall be forgiven; for it
was an error, and they have brought their
offering, an offering made by fire to
Yahweh, and their sin offering before
Yahweh, for their error.
26 All the congregation of the children of
Israel shall be forgiven, as well as the
stranger who lives as a foreigner among
them; for with regard to all the people, it
was done unwittingly.

† **15:4** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel ‡ **15:4** A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons. § **15:6** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel † **15:9** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

27 “ ‘If a person sins unwittingly, then he
shall offer a female goat a year old for a
sin offering.
28 The priest shall make atonement for
the soul who errs when he sins
unwittingly before Yahweh. He shall
make atonement for him; and he shall be
forgiven.
29 You shall have one law for him who
does anything unwittingly, for him who is
native-born among the children of Israel,
and for the stranger who lives as a
foreigner among them.
30 “ ‘But the soul who does anything
with a high hand, whether he is
native-born or a foreigner, blasphemes
Yahweh. That soul shall be cut off from
among his people.
31 Because he has despised Yahweh’s
word, and has broken his commandment,
that soul shall be utterly cut off. His
iniquity shall be on him.’ ”
32 While the children of Israel were in
the wilderness, they found a man
gathering sticks on the Sabbath day.
33 Those who found him gathering
sticks brought him to Moses and Aaron,
and to all the congregation.
34 They put him in custody, because it
had not been declared what should be
done to him.
35 Yahweh said to Moses, “The man shall
surely be put to death. All the
congregation shall stone him with stones
outside of the camp.”
36 All the congregation brought him
outside of the camp, and stoned him to
death with stones, as Yahweh
commanded Moses.
37 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
38 “Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them that they should make
themselves fringes‡ on the borders of
their garments throughout their
generations, and that they put on the
fringe§ of each border a cord of blue.
39 It shall be to you for a fringe,† that
you may see it, and remember all
Yahweh’s commandments, and do them;
and that you don’t follow your own heart
and your own eyes, after which you used
to play the prostitute;
40 so that you may remember and do all
my commandments, and be holy to your
God.
41 I am Yahweh your God, who brought
you out of the land of Egypt, to be your
God: I am Yahweh your God.”

16

1 Now Korah, the son of Izhar, the son of
Kohath, the son of Levi, with Dathan and
Abiram, the sons of Eliab, and On, the son
of Peleth, sons of Reuben, took some men.
2 They rose up before Moses, with some
of the children of Israel, two hundred fifty
princes of the congregation, called to the
assembly, men of renown.
3 They assembled themselves together
against Moses and against Aaron, and said
to them, “You take too much on yourself,
since all the congregation are holy,
everyone of them, and Yahweh is among
them! Why do you lift yourselves up
above Yahweh’s assembly?”
4 When Moses heard it, he fell on his
face.
5 He said to Korah and to all his
company, “In the morning, Yahweh will
show who are his, and who is holy, and
will cause him to come near to him. Even
him whom he shall choose, he will cause
to come near to him.
6 Do this: have Korah and all his
company take censers,
7 put fire in them, and put incense on
them before Yahweh tomorrow. It shall
be that the man whom Yahweh chooses,
he shall be holy. You have gone too far,
you sons of Levi!”
8 Moses said to Korah, “Hear now, you
sons of Levi!
9 Is it a small thing to you that the God of
Israel has separated you from the
congregation of Israel, to bring you near
to himself, to do the service of Yahweh’s
tabernacle, and to stand before the
congregation to minister to them;
10 and that he has brought you near,
and all your brothers the sons of Levi with
you? Do you seek the priesthood also?

‡ **15:38** or, tassels (Hebrew צִיצִת) § **15:38** or, tassel † **15:39** or, tassel

11 Therefore you and all your company
have gathered together against Yahweh!
What is Aaron that you complain against
him?"
12 Moses sent to call Dathan and
Abiram, the sons of Eliab; and they said,
"We won't come up!
13 Is it a small thing that you have
brought us up out of a land flowing with
milk and honey, to kill us in the
wilderness, but you must also make
yourself a prince over us?
14 Moreover you haven't brought us into
a land flowing with milk and honey, nor
given us inheritance of fields and
vineyards. Will you put out the eyes of
these men? We won't come up."
15 Moses was very angry, and said to
Yahweh, "Don't respect their offering. I
have not taken one donkey from them,
neither have I hurt one of them."
16 Moses said to Korah, "You and all
your company go before Yahweh, you,
and they, and Aaron, tomorrow.
17 Each man take his censer and put
incense on it, and each man bring before
Yahweh his censer, two hundred fifty
censers; you also, and Aaron, each with
his censer."
18 They each took his censer, and put
fire in it, and laid incense on it, and stood
at the door of the Tent of Meeting with
Moses and Aaron.
19 Korah assembled all the congregation
opposite them to the door of the Tent of
Meeting.

Yahweh's glory appeared to all the
congregation.
20 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron,
saying,
21 "Separate yourselves from among
this congregation, that I may consume
them in a moment!"
22 They fell on their faces, and said,
"God, the God of the spirits of all flesh,
shall one man sin, and will you be angry
with all the congregation?"
23 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
24 "Speak to the congregation, saying,
'Get away from around the tent of Korah,
Dathan, and Abiram!' "
25 Moses rose up and went to Dathan
and Abiram; and the elders of Israel
followed him.
26 He spoke to the congregation, saying,
"Depart, please, from the tents of these
wicked men, and touch nothing of theirs,
lest you be consumed in all their sins!"
27 So they went away from the tent of
Korah, Dathan, and Abiram, on every
side. Dathan and Abiram came out, and
stood at the door of their tents with their
wives, their sons, and their little ones.
28 Moses said, "Hereby you shall know
that Yahweh has sent me to do all these
works; for they are not from my own
mind.
29 If these men die the common death of
all men, or if they experience what all
men experience, then Yahweh hasn't sent
me.
30 But if Yahweh makes a new thing, and
the ground opens its mouth, and swallows
them up with all that belong to them, and
they go down alive into Sheol,† then you
shall understand that these men have
despised Yahweh."
31 As he finished speaking all these
words, the ground that was under them
split apart.
32 The earth opened its mouth and
swallowed them up with their
households, all of Korah's men, and all
their goods.
33 So they, and all that belonged to them
went down alive into Sheol.‡ The earth
closed on them, and they perished from
among the assembly.
34 All Israel that were around them fled
at their cry; for they said, "Lest the earth
swallow us up!"
35 Fire came out from Yahweh, and
devoured the two hundred fifty men who
offered the incense.
36 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
37 "Speak to Eleazar the son of Aaron the
priest, that he take up the censers out of
the burning, and scatter the fire away
from the camp; for they are holy,

† **16:30** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **16:33** Sheol is the place of the dead.

38 even the censers of those who sinned against their own lives. Let them be beaten into plates for a covering of the altar, for they offered them before Yahweh. Therefore they are holy. They shall be a sign to the children of Israel."
39 Eleazar the priest took the bronze censers which those who were burned had offered; and they beat them out for a covering of the altar,
40 to be a memorial to the children of Israel, to the end that no stranger who isn't of the offspring of Aaron, would come near to burn incense before Yahweh, that he not be as Korah and as his company; as Yahweh spoke to him by Moses.
41 But on the next day all the congregation of the children of Israel complained against Moses and against Aaron, saying, "You have killed Yahweh's people!"
42 When the congregation was assembled against Moses and against Aaron, they looked toward the Tent of Meeting. Behold, the cloud covered it, and Yahweh's glory appeared.
43 Moses and Aaron came to the front of the Tent of Meeting.
44 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
45 "Get away from among this congregation, that I may consume them in a moment!" They fell on their faces.
46 Moses said to Aaron, "Take your censer, put fire from the altar in it, lay incense on it, carry it quickly to the congregation, and make atonement for them; for wrath has gone out from Yahweh! The plague has begun."
47 Aaron did as Moses said, and ran into the middle of the assembly. The plague had already begun among the people. He put on the incense, and made atonement for the people.
48 He stood between the dead and the living; and the plague was stayed.
49 Now those who died by the plague were fourteen thousand seven hundred, in addition to those who died about the matter of Korah.
50 Aaron returned to Moses to the door of the Tent of Meeting, and the plague was stopped.

17

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, and take rods from them, one for each fathers' house, of all their princes according to their fathers' houses, twelve rods. Write each man's name on his rod.
3 You shall write Aaron's name on Levi's rod. There shall be one rod for each head of their fathers' houses.
4 You shall lay them up in the Tent of Meeting before the covenant, where I meet with you.
5 It shall happen that the rod of the man whom I shall choose shall bud. I will make the murmurings of the children of Israel, which they murmur against you, cease from me."
6 Moses spoke to the children of Israel; and all their princes gave him rods, for each prince one, according to their fathers' houses, a total of twelve rods. Aaron's rod was among their rods.
7 Moses laid up the rods before Yahweh in the Tent of the Testimony.
8 On the next day, Moses went into the Tent of the Testimony; and behold, Aaron's rod for the house of Levi had sprouted, budded, produced blossoms, and bore ripe almonds.
9 Moses brought out all the rods from before Yahweh to all the children of Israel. They looked, and each man took his rod.
10 Yahweh said to Moses, "Put back the rod of Aaron before the covenant, to be kept for a token against the children of rebellion; that you may make an end of their complaining against me, that they not die."
11 Moses did so. As Yahweh commanded him, so he did.
12 The children of Israel spoke to Moses, saying, "Behold, we perish! We are undone! We are all undone!
13 Everyone who keeps approaching Yahweh's tabernacle, dies! Will we all perish?"

18

1 Yahweh said to Aaron, "You and your sons and your fathers' house with you shall bear the iniquity of the sanctuary;

and you and your sons with you shall bear the iniquity of your priesthood.
2 Bring your brothers also, the tribe of Levi, the tribe of your father, near with you, that they may be joined to you, and minister to you; but you and your sons with you shall be before the Tent of the Testimony.
3 They shall keep your commands and the duty of the whole Tent; only they shall not come near to the vessels of the sanctuary and to the altar, that they not die, neither they nor you.
4 They shall be joined to you and keep the responsibility of the Tent of Meeting, for all the service of the Tent. A stranger shall not come near to you.
5 "You shall perform the duty of the sanctuary and the duty of the altar, that there be no more wrath on the children of Israel.
6 Behold, I myself have taken your brothers the Levites from among the children of Israel. They are a gift to you, dedicated to Yahweh, to do the service of the Tent of Meeting.
7 You and your sons with you shall keep your priesthood for everything of the altar, and for that within the veil. You shall serve. I give you the service of the priesthood as a gift. The stranger who comes near shall be put to death."
8 Yahweh spoke to Aaron, "Behold, I myself have given you the command of my wave offerings, even all the holy things of the children of Israel. I have given them to you by reason of the anointing, and to your sons, as a portion forever.
9 This shall be yours of the most holy things from the fire: every offering of theirs, even every meal offering of theirs, and every sin offering of theirs, and every trespass offering of theirs, which they shall give to me, shall be most holy for you and for your sons.
10 You shall eat of it like the most holy things. Every male shall eat of it. It shall be holy to you.
11 "This is yours, too: the wave offering of their gift, even all the wave offerings of the children of Israel. I have given them to you, and to your sons and to your daughters with you, as a portion forever. Everyone who is clean in your house shall eat of it.
12 "I have given to you all the best of the oil, all the best of the vintage, and of the grain, the first fruits of them which they give to Yahweh.
13 The first-ripe fruits of all that is in their land, which they bring to Yahweh, shall be yours. Everyone who is clean in your house shall eat of it.
14 "Everything devoted in Israel shall be yours.
15 Everything that opens the womb, of all flesh which they offer to Yahweh, both of man and animal, shall be yours. Nevertheless, you shall surely redeem the firstborn of man, and you shall redeem the firstborn of unclean animals.
16 You shall redeem those who are to be redeemed of them from a month old, according to your estimation, for five shekels of money, according to the shekel† of the sanctuary, which weighs twenty gerahs.‡
17 "But you shall not redeem the firstborn of a cow, or the firstborn of a sheep, or the firstborn of a goat. They are holy. You shall sprinkle their blood on the altar, and shall burn their fat for an offering made by fire, for a pleasant aroma to Yahweh.
18 Their meat shall be yours, as the wave offering breast and as the right thigh, it shall be yours.
19 All the wave offerings of the holy things which the children of Israel offer to Yahweh, I have given you and your sons and your daughters with you, as a portion forever. It is a covenant of salt forever before Yahweh to you and to your offspring with you."
20 Yahweh said to Aaron, "You shall have no inheritance in their land, neither shall you have any portion among them. I

† **18:16** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.
‡ **18:16** A gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains.

am your portion and your inheritance among the children of Israel.

21 "To the children of Levi, behold, I have given all the tithe in Israel for an inheritance, in return for their service which they serve, even the service of the Tent of Meeting.
22 Henceforth the children of Israel shall not come near the Tent of Meeting, lest they bear sin, and die.
23 But the Levites shall do the service of the Tent of Meeting, and they shall bear their iniquity. It shall be a statute forever throughout your generations. Among the children of Israel, they shall have no inheritance.
24 For the tithe of the children of Israel, which they offer as a wave offering to Yahweh, I have given to the Levites for an inheritance. Therefore I have said to them, 'Among the children of Israel they shall have no inheritance.' "
25 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
26 "Moreover you shall speak to the Levites, and tell them, 'When you take of the children of Israel the tithe which I have given you from them for your inheritance, then you shall offer up a wave offering of it for Yahweh, a tithe of the tithe.
27 Your wave offering shall be credited to you, as though it were the grain of the threshing floor, and as the fullness of the wine press.
28 Thus you also shall offer a wave offering to Yahweh of all your tithes, which you receive of the children of Israel; and of it you shall give Yahweh's wave offering to Aaron the priest.
29 Out of all your gifts, you shall offer every wave offering to Yahweh, of all its best parts, even the holy part of it.'
30 "Therefore you shall tell them, 'When you heave its best from it, then it shall be credited to the Levites as the increase of the threshing floor, and as the increase of the wine press.
31 You may eat it anywhere, you and your households, for it is your reward in return for your service in the Tent of Meeting.
32 You shall bear no sin by reason of it, when you have heaved from it its best. You shall not profane the holy things of the children of Israel, that you not die.' "

19

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Aaron, saying,
2 "This is the statute of the law which Yahweh has commanded. Tell the children of Israel to bring you a red heifer without spot, in which is no defect, and which was never yoked.
3 You shall give her to Eleazar the priest, and he shall bring her outside of the camp, and one shall kill her before his face.
4 Eleazar the priest shall take some of her blood with his finger, and sprinkle her blood toward the front of the Tent of Meeting seven times.
5 One shall burn the heifer in his sight; her skin, and her meat, and her blood, with her dung, shall he burn.
6 The priest shall take cedar wood, hyssop, and scarlet, and cast it into the middle of the burning of the heifer.
7 Then the priest shall wash his clothes, and he shall bathe his flesh in water, and afterward he shall come into the camp, and the priest shall be unclean until the evening.
8 He who burns her shall wash his clothes in water, and bathe his flesh in water, and shall be unclean until the evening.
9 "A man who is clean shall gather up the ashes of the heifer, and lay them up outside of the camp in a clean place; and it shall be kept for the congregation of the children of Israel for use in water for cleansing impurity. It is a sin offering.
10 He who gathers the ashes of the heifer shall wash his clothes, and be unclean until the evening. It shall be to the children of Israel, and to the stranger who lives as a foreigner among them, for a statute forever.
11 "He who touches the dead body of any man shall be unclean seven days.
12 He shall purify himself with water on the third day, and on the seventh day he shall be clean; but if he doesn't purify

himself the third day, then the seventh day he shall not be clean.
13 Whoever touches a dead person, the body of a man who has died, and doesn't purify himself, defiles Yahweh's tabernacle; and that soul shall be cut off from Israel; because the water for impurity was not sprinkled on him, he shall be unclean. His uncleanness is yet on him.
14 "This is the law when a man dies in a tent: everyone who comes into the tent, and everyone who is in the tent, shall be unclean seven days.
15 Every open vessel, which has no covering bound on it, is unclean.
16 "Whoever in the open field touches one who is slain with a sword, or a dead body, or a bone of a man, or a grave, shall be unclean seven days.
17 "For the unclean, they shall take of the ashes of the burning of the sin offering; and running water shall be poured on them in a vessel.
18 A clean person shall take hyssop, dip it in the water, and sprinkle it on the tent, on all the vessels, on the persons who were there, and on him who touched the bone, or the slain, or the dead, or the grave.
19 The clean person shall sprinkle on the unclean on the third day, and on the seventh day. On the seventh day, he shall purify him. He shall wash his clothes and bathe himself in water, and shall be clean at evening.
20 But the man who shall be unclean, and shall not purify himself, that soul shall be cut off from among the assembly, because he has defiled the sanctuary of Yahweh. The water for impurity has not been sprinkled on him. He is unclean.
21 It shall be a perpetual statute to them. He who sprinkles the water for impurity shall wash his clothes, and he who touches the water for impurity shall be unclean until evening.
22 "Whatever the unclean person touches shall be unclean; and the soul that touches it shall be unclean until evening."

20

1 The children of Israel, even the whole congregation, came into the wilderness of Zin in the first month. The people stayed in Kadesh. Miriam died there, and was buried there.
2 There was no water for the congregation; and they assembled themselves together against Moses and against Aaron.
3 The people quarreled with Moses, and spoke, saying, "We wish that we had died when our brothers died before Yahweh!
4 Why have you brought Yahweh's assembly into this wilderness, that we should die there, we and our animals?
5 Why have you made us to come up out of Egypt, to bring us in to this evil place? It is no place of seed, or of figs, or of vines, or of pomegranates; neither is there any water to drink."

6 Moses and Aaron went from the presence of the assembly to the door of the Tent of Meeting, and fell on their faces. Yahweh's glory appeared to them.
7 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
8 "Take the rod, and assemble the congregation, you, and Aaron your brother, and speak to the rock before their eyes, that it pour out its water. You shall bring water to them out of the rock; so you shall give the congregation and their livestock drink."

9 Moses took the rod from before Yahweh, as he commanded him.
10 Moses and Aaron gathered the assembly together before the rock, and he said to them, "Hear now, you rebels! Shall we bring water out of this rock for you?"
11 Moses lifted up his hand, and struck the rock with his rod twice, and water came out abundantly. The congregation and their livestock drank.

12 Yahweh said to Moses and Aaron, "Because you didn't believe in me, to sanctify me in the eyes of the children of Israel, therefore you shall not bring this assembly into the land which I have given them."

† **20:13** "Meribah" means "quarreling".

13 These are the waters of Meribah;† because the children of Israel strove with Yahweh, and he was sanctified in them.
14 Moses sent messengers from Kadesh to the king of Edom, saying:
"Your brother Israel says: You know all the travail that has happened to us;
15 how our fathers went down into Egypt, and we lived in Egypt a long time. The Egyptians mistreated us and our fathers.
16 When we cried to Yahweh, he heard our voice, sent an angel, and brought us out of Egypt. Behold, we are in Kadesh, a city in the edge of your border.
17 "Please let us pass through your land. We will not pass through field or through vineyard, neither will we drink from the water of the wells. We will go along the king's highway. We will not turn away to the right hand nor to the left, until we have passed your border."
18 Edom said to him, "You shall not pass through me, lest I come out with the sword against you."
19 The children of Israel said to him, "We will go up by the highway; and if we drink your water, I and my livestock, then I will give its price. Only let me, without doing anything else, pass through on my feet."
20 He said, "You shall not pass through." Edom came out against him with many people, and with a strong hand.
21 Thus Edom refused to give Israel passage through his border, so Israel turned away from him.
22 They traveled from Kadesh, and the children of Israel, even the whole congregation, came to Mount Hor.
23 Yahweh spoke to Moses and Aaron in Mount Hor, by the border of the land of Edom, saying,
24 "Aaron shall be gathered to his people; for he shall not enter into the land which I have given to the children of Israel, because you rebelled against my word at the waters of Meribah.
25 Take Aaron and Eleazar his son, and bring them up to Mount Hor;
26 and strip Aaron of his garments, and put them on Eleazar his son. Aaron shall be gathered, and shall die there."
27 Moses did as Yahweh commanded. They went up onto Mount Hor in the sight of all the congregation.
28 Moses stripped Aaron of his garments, and put them on Eleazar his son. Aaron died there on the top of the mountain, and Moses and Eleazar came down from the mountain.
29 When all the congregation saw that Aaron was dead, they wept for Aaron thirty days, even all the house of Israel.

21

1 The Canaanite, the king of Arad, who lived in the South, heard that Israel came by the way of Atharim. He fought against Israel, and took some of them captive.
2 Israel vowed a vow to Yahweh, and said, "If you will indeed deliver this people into my hand, then I will utterly destroy their cities."
3 Yahweh listened to the voice of Israel, and delivered up the Canaanites; and they utterly destroyed them and their cities. The name of the place was called Hormah.†
4 They traveled from Mount Hor by the way to the Red Sea, to go around the land of Edom. The soul of the people was very discouraged because of the journey.
5 The people spoke against God and against Moses: "Why have you brought us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? For there is no bread, there is no water, and our soul loathes this disgusting food!"
6 Yahweh sent venomous snakes among the people, and they bit the people. Many people of Israel died.
7 The people came to Moses, and said, "We have sinned, because we have spoken against Yahweh and against you. Pray to Yahweh, that he take away the serpents from us." Moses prayed for the people.
8 Yahweh said to Moses, "Make a venomous snake, and set it on a pole. It shall happen that everyone who is bitten, when he sees it, shall live."

† **21:3** "Hormah" means "destruction".

9 Moses made a serpent of bronze, and
set it on the pole. If a serpent had bitten
any man, when he looked at the serpent of
bronze, he lived.
10 The children of Israel traveled, and
encamped in Oboth.
11 They traveled from Oboth, and
encamped at Iyeabarim, in the wilderness
which is before Moab, toward the sunrise.
12 From there they traveled, and
encamped in the valley of Zered.
13 From there they traveled, and
encamped on the other side of the Arnon,
which is in the wilderness that comes out
of the border of the Amorites; for the
Arnon is the border of Moab, between
Moab and the Amorites.
14 Therefore it is said in *The Book of the
Wars of Yahweh*, "Vaheb in Suphah, the
valleys of the Arnon,
15 the slope of the valleys that incline
toward the dwelling of Ar, leans on the
border of Moab."
16 From there they traveled to Beer; that
is the well of which Yahweh said to Moses,
"Gather the people together, and I will
give them water."
17 Then Israel sang this song:
"Spring up, well! Sing to it,
18 the well, which the princes dug,
which the nobles of the people dug,
with the scepter, and with their
poles."
From the wilderness they traveled to
Mattanah;
19 and from Mattanah to Nahaliel; and
from Nahaliel to Bamoth;
20 and from Bamoth to the valley that is
in the field of Moab, to the top of Pisgah,
which looks down on the desert.
21 Israel sent messengers to Sihon king
of the Amorites, saying,
22 "Let me pass through your land. We
will not turn away into field or vineyard.
We will not drink of the water of the wells.
We will go by the king's highway, until we
have passed your border."
23 Sihon would not allow Israel to pass
through his border, but Sihon gathered all
his people together, and went out against
Israel into the wilderness, and came to
Jahaz. He fought against Israel.
24 Israel struck him with the edge of the
sword, and possessed his land from the
Arnon to the Jabbok, even to the children
of Ammon; for the border of the children
of Ammon was fortified.
25 Israel took all these cities. Israel lived
in all the cities of the Amorites, in
Heshbon, and in all its villages.
26 For Heshbon was the city of Sihon the
king of the Amorites, who had fought
against the former king of Moab, and
taken all his land out of his hand, even to
the Arnon.
27 Therefore those who speak in
proverbs say,
"Come to Heshbon.
Let the city of Sihon be built and
established;
28 for a fire has gone out of Heshbon,
a flame from the city of Sihon.
It has devoured Ar of Moab,
The lords of the high places of the
Arnon.
29 Woe to you, Moab!
You are undone, people of Chemosh!
He has given his sons as fugitives,
and his daughters into captivity,
to Sihon king of the Amorites.
30 We have shot at them.
Heshbon has perished even to Dibon.
We have laid waste even to Nophah,
Which reaches to Medeba."
31 Thus Israel lived in the land of the
Amorites.
32 Moses sent to spy out Jazer. They took
its villages, and drove out the Amorites
who were there.
33 They turned and went up by the way
of Bashan. Og the king of Bashan went out
against them, he and all his people, to
battle at Edrei.
34 Yahweh said to Moses, "Don't fear
him, for I have delivered him into your
hand, with all his people, and his land.
You shall do to him as you did to Sihon
king of the Amorites, who lived at
Heshbon."
35 So they struck him, with his sons and
all his people, until there were no
survivors; and they possessed his land.

22

1 The children of Israel traveled, and
encamped in the plains of Moab beyond
the Jordan at Jericho.
2 Balak the son of Zippor saw all that
Israel had done to the Amorites.
3 Moab was very afraid of the people,
because they were many. Moab was
distressed because of the children of
Israel.
4 Moab said to the elders of Midian,
"Now this multitude will lick up all that is
around us, as the ox licks up the grass of
the field."
Balak the son of Zippor was king of
Moab at that time.
5 He sent messengers to Balaam the son
of Beor, to Pethor, which is by the River, to
the land of the children of his people, to
call him, saying, "Behold, there is a people
who came out of Egypt. Behold, they
cover the surface of the earth, and they
are staying opposite me.
6 Please come now therefore, and curse
this people for me; for they are too mighty
for me. Perhaps I shall prevail, that we
may strike them, and that I may drive
them out of the land; for I know that he
whom you bless is blessed, and he whom
you curse is cursed."
7 The elders of Moab and the elders of
Midian departed with the rewards of
divination in their hand. They came to
Balaam, and spoke to him the words of
Balak.
8 He said to them, "Lodge here this
night, and I will bring you word again, as
Yahweh shall speak to me." The princes of
Moab stayed with Balaam.
9 God came to Balaam, and said, "Who
are these men with you?"
10 Balaam said to God, "Balak the son of
Zippor, king of Moab, has said to me,
11 'Behold, the people that has come out
of Egypt covers the surface of the earth.
Now, come curse them for me. Perhaps I
shall be able to fight against them, and
shall drive them out.' "
12 God said to Balaam, "You shall not go
with them. You shall not curse the people,
for they are blessed."
13 Balaam rose up in the morning, and
said to the princes of Balak, "Go to your
land; for Yahweh refuses to permit me to
go with you."
14 The princes of Moab rose up, and they
went to Balak, and said, "Balaam refuses
to come with us."
15 Balak again sent princes, more, and
more honorable than they.
16 They came to Balaam, and said to
him, "Balak the son of Zippor says, 'Please
let nothing hinder you from coming to me,
17 for I will promote you to very great
honor, and whatever you say to me I will
do. Please come therefore, and curse this
people for me.' "
18 Balaam answered the servants of
Balak, "If Balak would give me his house
full of silver and gold, I can't go beyond
the word of Yahweh my God, to do less or
more.
19 Now therefore please stay here
tonight as well, that I may know what else
Yahweh will speak to me."
20 God came to Balaam at night, and said
to him, "If the men have come to call you,
rise up, go with them; but only the word
which I speak to you, that you shall do."
21 Balaam rose up in the morning, and
saddled his donkey, and went with the
princes of Moab.
22 God's anger burned because he went;
and Yahweh's angel placed himself in the
way as an adversary against him. Now he
was riding on his donkey, and his two
servants were with him.
23 The donkey saw Yahweh's angel
standing in the way, with his sword
drawn in his hand; and the donkey turned
out of the path, and went into the field.
Balaam struck the donkey, to turn her
into the path.
24 Then Yahweh's angel stood in a
narrow path between the vineyards, a
wall being on this side, and a wall on that
side.
25 The donkey saw Yahweh's angel, and
she thrust herself to the wall, and crushed
Balaam's foot against the wall. He struck
her again.

26 Yahweh's angel went further, and
stood in a narrow place, where there was
no way to turn either to the right hand or
to the left.
27 The donkey saw Yahweh's angel, and
she lay down under Balaam. Balaam's
anger burned, and he struck the donkey
with his staff.
28 Yahweh opened the mouth of the
donkey, and she said to Balaam, "What
have I done to you, that you have struck
me these three times?"
29 Balaam said to the donkey, "Because
you have mocked me, I wish there were a
sword in my hand, for now I would have
killed you."
30 The donkey said to Balaam, "Am I not
your donkey, on which you have ridden
all your life long until today? Was I ever in
the habit of doing so to you?"

He said, "No."

31 Then Yahweh opened the eyes of
Balaam, and he saw Yahweh's angel
standing in the way, with his sword
drawn in his hand; and he bowed his
head, and fell on his face.
32 Yahweh's angel said to him, "Why
have you struck your donkey these three
times? Behold, I have come out as an
adversary, because your way is perverse
before me.
33 The donkey saw me, and turned away
before me these three times. Unless she
had turned away from me, surely now I
would have killed you, and saved her
alive."
34 Balaam said to Yahweh's angel, "I
have sinned; for I didn't know that you
stood in the way against me. Now
therefore, if it displeases you, I will go
back again."
35 Yahweh's angel said to Balaam, "Go
with the men; but you shall only speak the
word that I shall speak to you."

So Balaam went with the princes of
Balak.
36 When Balak heard that Balaam had
come, he went out to meet him to the City
of Moab, which is on the border of the
Arnon, which is in the utmost part of the
border.
37 Balak said to Balaam, "Didn't I
earnestly send for you to summon you?
Why didn't you come to me? Am I not able
indeed to promote you to honor?"
38 Balaam said to Balak, "Behold, I have
come to you. Have I now any power at all
to speak anything? I will speak the word
that God puts in my mouth."
39 Balaam went with Balak, and they
came to Kiriath Huzoth.
40 Balak sacrificed cattle and sheep, and
sent to Balaam, and to the princes who
were with him.
41 In the morning, Balak took Balaam,
and brought him up into the high places
of Baal; and he saw from there part of the
people.

23

1 Balaam said to Balak, "Build here
seven altars for me, and prepare here
seven bulls and seven rams for me."
2 Balak did as Balaam had spoken; and
Balak and Balaam offered on every altar a
bull and a ram.
3 Balaam said to Balak, "Stand by your
burnt offering, and I will go. Perhaps
Yahweh will come to meet me. Whatever
he shows me I will tell you."

He went to a bare height.

4 God met Balaam, and he said to him, "I
have prepared the seven altars, and I
have offered up a bull and a ram on every
altar."
5 Yahweh put a word in Balaam's
mouth, and said, "Return to Balak, and
thus you shall speak."
6 He returned to him, and behold, he
was standing by his burnt offering, he,
and all the princes of Moab.
7 He took up his parable, and said,
"From Aram has Balak brought me,
the king of Moab from the mountains
of the East.
Come, curse Jacob for me.
Come, defy Israel.
8 How shall I curse whom God has not
cursed?
How shall I defy whom Yahweh has
not defied?
9 For from the top of the rocks I see him.
From the hills I see him.
Behold, it is a people that dwells alone,

and shall not be listed among the
nations.
10 Who can count the dust of Jacob,
or count the fourth part of Israel?
Let me die the death of the righteous!
Let my last end be like his!"
11 Balak said to Balaam, "What have you
done to me? I took you to curse my
enemies, and behold, you have blessed
them altogether."
12 He answered and said, "Must I not
take heed to speak that which Yahweh
puts in my mouth?"
13 Balak said to him, "Please come with
me to another place, where you may see
them. You shall see just part of them, and
shall not see them all. Curse them from
there for me."
14 He took him into the field of Zophim,
to the top of Pisgah, and built seven altars,
and offered up a bull and a ram on every
altar.
15 He said to Balak, "Stand here by your
burnt offering, while I meet God over
there."
16 Yahweh met Balaam, and put a word
in his mouth, and said, "Return to Balak,
and say this."
17 He came to him, and behold, he was
standing by his burnt offering, and the
princes of Moab with him. Balak said to
him, "What has Yahweh spoken?"
18 He took up his parable, and said,
"Rise up, Balak, and hear!
Listen to me, you son of Zippor.
19 God is not a man, that he should lie,
nor a son of man, that he should
repent.
Has he said, and he won't do it?
Or has he spoken, and he won't make
it good?
20 Behold, I have received a command to
bless.
He has blessed, and I can't reverse it.
21 He has not seen iniquity in Jacob.
Neither has he seen perverseness in
Israel.
Yahweh his God is with him.
The shout of a king is among them.
22 God brings them out of Egypt.
He has as it were the strength of the
wild ox.
23 Surely there is no enchantment with
Jacob;
neither is there any divination with
Israel.
Now it shall be said of Jacob and of Israel,
'What has God done!'
24 Behold, a people rises up as a lioness.
As a lion he lifts himself up.
He shall not lie down until he eats of the
prey,
and drinks the blood of the slain."
25 Balak said to Balaam, "Neither curse
them at all, nor bless them at all."
26 But Balaam answered Balak, "Didn't I
tell you, saying, 'All that Yahweh speaks,
that I must do'?"
27 Balak said to Balaam, "Come now, I
will take you to another place; perhaps it
will please God that you may curse them
for me from there."
28 Balak took Balaam to the top of Peor,
that looks down on the desert.
29 Balaam said to Balak, "Build seven
altars for me here, and prepare seven
bulls and seven rams for me here."
30 Balak did as Balaam had said, and
offered up a bull and a ram on every altar.

24

1 When Balaam saw that it pleased
Yahweh to bless Israel, he didn't go, as at
the other times, to use divination, but he
set his face toward the wilderness.
2 Balaam lifted up his eyes, and he saw
Israel dwelling according to their tribes;
and the Spirit of God came on him.
3 He took up his parable, and said,
"Balaam the son of Beor says,
the man whose eyes are open says;
4 he says, who hears the words of God,
who sees the vision of the Almighty,
falling down, and having his eyes
open:
5 How goodly are your tents, Jacob,
and your dwellings, Israel!
6 As valleys they are spread out,
as gardens by the riverside,
as aloes which Yahweh has planted,
as cedar trees beside the waters.
7 Water shall flow from his buckets.
His seed shall be in many waters.
His king shall be higher than Agag.
His kingdom shall be exalted.

8 God brings him out of Egypt.
He has as it were the strength of the wild ox.
He shall consume the nations his adversaries,
shall break their bones in pieces,
and pierce them with his arrows.
9 He couched, he lay down as a lion,
as a lioness;
who shall rouse him up?
Everyone who blesses you is blessed.
Everyone who curses you is cursed."
10 Balak's anger burned against Balaam, and he struck his hands together. Balak said to Balaam, "I called you to curse my enemies, and, behold, you have altogether blessed them these three times.
11 Therefore, flee to your place, now! I thought to promote you to great honor; but, behold, Yahweh has kept you back from honor."
12 Balaam said to Balak, "Didn't I also tell your messengers whom you sent to me, saying,
13 'If Balak would give me his house full of silver and gold, I can't go beyond Yahweh's word, to do either good or bad from my own mind. I will say what Yahweh says'?
14 Now, behold, I go to my people. Come, I will inform you what this people shall do to your people in the latter days."
15 He took up his parable, and said,
"Balaam the son of Beor says,
the man whose eyes are open says;
16 he says, who hears the words of God,
knows the knowledge of the Most High,
and who sees the vision of the Almighty,
falling down, and having his eyes open:
17 I see him, but not now.
I see him, but not near.
A star will come out of Jacob.
A scepter will rise out of Israel,
and shall strike through the corners of Moab,
and crush all the sons of Sheth.
18 Edom shall be a possession.
Seir, his enemy, also shall be a possession,
while Israel does valiantly.
19 Out of Jacob shall one have dominion,
and shall destroy the remnant from the city."
20 He looked at Amalek, and took up his parable, and said,
"Amalek was the first of the nations,
but his latter end shall come to destruction."
21 He looked at the Kenite, and took up his parable, and said,
"Your dwelling place is strong.
Your nest is set in the rock.
22 Nevertheless Kain shall be wasted,
until Asshur carries you away captive."
23 He took up his parable, and said,
"Alas, who shall live when God does this?
24 But ships shall come from the coast of Kittim.
They shall afflict Asshur, and shall afflict Eber.
He also shall come to destruction."
25 Balaam rose up, and went and returned to his place; and Balak also went his way.

25

1 Israel stayed in Shittim; and the people began to play the prostitute with the daughters of Moab;
2 for they called the people to the sacrifices of their gods. The people ate and bowed down to their gods.
3 Israel joined himself to Baal Peor, and Yahweh's anger burned against Israel.
4 Yahweh said to Moses, "Take all the chiefs of the people, and hang them up to Yahweh before the sun, that the fierce anger of Yahweh may turn away from Israel."
5 Moses said to the judges of Israel, "Everyone kill his men who have joined themselves to Baal Peor."
6 Behold, one of the children of Israel came and brought to his brothers a Midianite woman in the sight of Moses, and in the sight of all the congregation of the children of Israel, while they were

weeping at the door of the Tent of Meeting.
7 When Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, saw it, he rose up from the middle of the congregation, and took a spear in his hand.
8 He went after the man of Israel into the pavilion, and thrust both of them through, the man of Israel, and the woman through her body. So the plague was stopped among the children of Israel.
9 Those who died by the plague were twenty-four thousand.
10 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
11 "Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, has turned my wrath away from the children of Israel, in that he was jealous with my jealousy among them, so that I didn't consume the children of Israel in my jealousy.
12 Therefore say, 'Behold, I give to him my covenant of peace.
13 It shall be to him, and to his offspring after him, the covenant of an everlasting priesthood, because he was jealous for his God, and made atonement for the children of Israel.' "
14 Now the name of the man of Israel that was slain, who was slain with the Midianite woman, was Zimri, the son of Salu, a prince of a fathers' house among the Simeonites.
15 The name of the Midianite woman who was slain was Cozbi, the daughter of Zur. He was head of the people of a fathers' house in Midian.
16 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
17 "Harass the Midianites, and strike them;
18 for they harassed you with their wiles, wherein they have deceived you in the matter of Peor, and in the incident regarding Cozbi, the daughter of the prince of Midian, their sister, who was slain on the day of the plague in the matter of Peor."

26

1 After the plague, Yahweh spoke to Moses and to Eleazar the son of Aaron the priest, saying,
2 "Take a census of all the congregation of the children of Israel, from twenty years old and upward, by their fathers' houses, all who are able to go out to war in Israel."
3 Moses and Eleazar the priest spoke with them in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho, saying,
4 "Take a census, from twenty years old and upward, as Yahweh commanded Moses and the children of Israel."
These are those who came out of the land of Egypt.
5 Reuben, the firstborn of Israel; the sons of Reuben: of Hanoch, the family of the Hanochites; of Pallu, the family of the Palluites;
6 of Hezron, the family of the Hezronites; of Carmi, the family of the Carmites.
7 These are the families of the Reubenites; and those who were counted of them were forty-three thousand seven hundred thirty.
8 The son of Pallu: Eliab.
9 The sons of Eliab: Nemuel, Dathan, and Abiram. These are that Dathan and Abiram who were called by the congregation, who rebelled against Moses and against Aaron in the company of Korah when they rebelled against Yahweh;
10 and the earth opened its mouth, and swallowed them up together with Korah when that company died; at the time the fire devoured two hundred fifty men, and they became a sign.
11 Notwithstanding, the sons of Korah didn't die.
12 The sons of Simeon after their families: of Nemuel, the family of the Nemuelites; of Jamin, the family of the Jaminites; of Jachin, the family of the Jachinites;
13 of Zerah, the family of the Zerahites; of Shaul, the family of the Shaulites.
14 These are the families of the Simeonites, twenty-two thousand two hundred.
15 The sons of Gad after their families: of Zephon, the family of the Zephonites; of Haggi, the family of the Haggites; of Shuni, the family of the Shunites;

16 of Ozni, the family of the Oznites; of
Eri, the family of the Erites;
17 of Arod, the family of the Arodites; of
Areli, the family of the Arelites.
18 These are the families of the sons of
Gad according to those who were counted
of them, forty thousand and five hundred.
19 The sons of Judah: Er and Onan. Er
and Onan died in the land of Canaan.
20 The sons of Judah after their families
were: of Shelah, the family of the
Shelanites; of Perez, the family of the
Perezites; of Zerah, the family of the
Zerahites.
21 The sons of Perez were: of Hezron,
the family of the Hezronites; of Hamul,
the family of the Hamulites.
22 These are the families of Judah
according to those who were counted of
them, seventy-six thousand five hundred.
23 The sons of Issachar after their
families: of Tola, the family of the Tolaites;
of Puvah, the family of the Punites;
24 of Jashub, the family of the Jashubites;
of Shimron, the family of the Shimronites.
25 These are the families of Issachar
according to those who were counted of
them, sixty-four thousand three hundred.
26 The sons of Zebulun after their
families: of Sered, the family of the
Seredites; of Elon, the family of the
Elonites; of Jahleel, the family of the
Jahleelites.
27 These are the families of the
Zebulunites according to those who were
counted of them, sixty thousand five
hundred.
28 The sons of Joseph after their
families: Manasseh and Ephraim.
29 The sons of Manasseh: of Machir, the
family of the Machirites; and Machir
became the father of Gilead; of Gilead, the
family of the Gileadites.
30 These are the sons of Gilead: of Iezer,
the family of the Iezerites; of Helek, the
family of the Helekites;
31 and Asriel, the family of the
Asrielites; and Shechem, the family of the
Shechemites;
32 and Shemida, the family of the
Shemidaites; and Hepher, the family of
the Hepherites.
33 Zelophehad the son of Hepher had no
sons, but daughters: and the names of the
daughters of Zelophehad were Mahlah,
Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.
34 These are the families of Manasseh.
Those who were counted of them were
fifty-two thousand seven hundred.
35 These are the sons of Ephraim after
their families: of Shuthelah, the family of
the Shuthelahites; of Becher, the family of
the Becherites; of Tahan, the family of the
Tahanites.
36 These are the sons of Shuthelah: of
Eran, the family of the Eranites.
37 These are the families of the sons of
Ephraim according to those who were
counted of them, thirty-two thousand five
hundred. These are the sons of Joseph
after their families.
38 The sons of Benjamin after their
families: of Bela, the family of the
Belaites; of Ashbel, the family of the
Ashbelites; of Ahiram, the family of the
Ahiramites;
39 of Shephupham, the family of the
Shuphamites; of Hupham, the family of
the Huphamites.
40 The sons of Bela were Ard and
Naaman: the family of the Ardites; and of
Naaman, the family of the Naamites.
41 These are the sons of Benjamin after
their families; and those who were
counted of them were forty-five thousand
six hundred.
42 These are the sons of Dan after their
families: of Shuham, the family of the
Shuhamites. These are the families of Dan
after their families.
43 All the families of the Shuhamites,
according to those who were counted of
them, were sixty-four thousand four
hundred.
44 The sons of Asher after their families:
of Imnah, the family of the Imnites; of
Ishvi, the family of the Ishvites; of Beriah,
the family of the Berites.
45 Of the sons of Beriah: of Heber, the
family of the Heberites; of Malchiel, the
family of the Malchielites.
46 The name of the daughter of Asher
was Serah.
47 These are the families of the sons of
Asher according to those who were

counted of them, fifty-three thousand four hundred.
48 The sons of Naphtali after their families: of Jahzeel, the family of the Jahzeelites; of Guni, the family of the Gunites;
49 of Jezer, the family of the Jezerites; of Shillem, the family of the Shillemites.
50 These are the families of Naphtali according to their families; and those who were counted of them were forty-five thousand four hundred.
51 These are those who were counted of the children of Israel, six hundred one thousand seven hundred thirty.
52 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
53 "To these the land shall be divided for an inheritance according to the number of names.
54 To the more you shall give the more inheritance, and to the fewer you shall give the less inheritance. To everyone according to those who were counted of him shall his inheritance be given.
55 Notwithstanding, the land shall be divided by lot. According to the names of the tribes of their fathers they shall inherit.
56 According to the lot shall their inheritance be divided between the more and the fewer."
57 These are those who were counted of the Levites after their families: of Gershon, the family of the Gershonites; of Kohath, the family of the Kohathites; of Merari, the family of the Merarites.
58 These are the families of Levi: the family of the Libnites, the family of the Hebronites, the family of the Mahlites, the family of the Mushites, and the family of the Korahites. Kohath became the father of Amram.
59 The name of Amram's wife was Jochebed, the daughter of Levi, who was born to Levi in Egypt. She bore to Amram Aaron and Moses, and Miriam their sister.
60 To Aaron were born Nadab and Abihu, Eleazar and Ithamar.
61 Nadab and Abihu died when they offered strange fire before Yahweh.
62 Those who were counted of them were twenty-three thousand, every male from a month old and upward; for they were not counted among the children of Israel, because there was no inheritance given them among the children of Israel.
63 These are those who were counted by Moses and Eleazar the priest, who counted the children of Israel in the plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho.
64 But among these there was not a man of them who were counted by Moses and Aaron the priest, who counted the children of Israel in the wilderness of Sinai.
65 For Yahweh had said of them, "They shall surely die in the wilderness." There was not a man left of them, except Caleb the son of Jephunneh, and Joshua the son of Nun.

27

1 Then the daughters of Zelophehad, the son of Hepher, the son of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, of the families of Manasseh the son of Joseph came near. These are the names of his daughters: Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.
2 They stood before Moses, before Eleazar the priest, and before the princes and all the congregation, at the door of the Tent of Meeting, saying,
3 "Our father died in the wilderness. He was not among the company of those who gathered themselves together against Yahweh in the company of Korah, but he died in his own sin. He had no sons.
4 Why should the name of our father be taken away from among his family, because he had no son? Give to us a possession among the brothers of our father."
5 Moses brought their cause before Yahweh.
6 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
7 "The daughters of Zelophehad speak right. You shall surely give them a possession of an inheritance among their father's brothers. You shall cause the inheritance of their father to pass to them.
8 You shall speak to the children of Israel, saying, 'If a man dies, and has no son, then you shall cause his inheritance to pass to his daughter.

9 If he has no daughter, then you shall
give his inheritance to his brothers.
10 If he has no brothers, then you shall
give his inheritance to his father's
brothers.
11 If his father has no brothers, then you
shall give his inheritance to his kinsman
who is next to him of his family, and he
shall possess it. This shall be a statute and
ordinance for the children of Israel, as
Yahweh commanded Moses.' "
12 Yahweh said to Moses, "Go up into
this mountain of Abarim, and see the land
which I have given to the children of
Israel.
13 When you have seen it, you also shall
be gathered to your people, as Aaron your
brother was gathered;
14 because in the strife of the
congregation, you rebelled against my
word in the wilderness of Zin, to honor
me as holy at the waters before their
eyes." (These are the waters of Meribah of
Kadesh in the wilderness of Zin.)
15 Moses spoke to Yahweh, saying,
16 "Let Yahweh, the God of the spirits of
all flesh, appoint a man over the
congregation,
17 who may go out before them, and who
may come in before them, and who may
lead them out, and who may bring them
in, that the congregation of Yahweh may
not be as sheep which have no shepherd."
18 Yahweh said to Moses, "Take Joshua
the son of Nun, a man in whom is the
Spirit, and lay your hand on him.
19 Set him before Eleazar the priest, and
before all the congregation; and
commission him in their sight.
20 You shall give authority to him, that
all the congregation of the children of
Israel may obey.
21 He shall stand before Eleazar the
priest, who shall inquire for him by the
judgment of the Urim before Yahweh. At
his word they shall go out, and at his word
they shall come in, both he and all the
children of Israel with him, even all the
congregation."
22 Moses did as Yahweh commanded
him. He took Joshua, and set him before
Eleazar the priest and before all the
congregation.
23 He laid his hands on him and
commissioned him, as Yahweh spoke by
Moses.

28

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Command the children of Israel, and
tell them, 'See that you present my
offering, my food for my offerings made
by fire, as a pleasant aroma to me, in their
due season.'
3 You shall tell them, 'This is the offering
made by fire which you shall offer to
Yahweh: male lambs a year old without
defect, two day by day, for a continual
burnt offering.
4 You shall offer the one lamb in the
morning, and you shall offer the other
lamb at evening,
5 with one tenth of an ephah† of fine
flour for a meal offering, mixed with the
fourth part of a hin‡ of beaten oil.
6 It is a continual burnt offering which
was ordained in Mount Sinai for a
pleasant aroma, an offering made by fire
to Yahweh.
7 Its drink offering shall be the fourth
part of a hin§ for each lamb. You shall
pour out a drink offering of strong drink
to Yahweh in the holy place.
8 The other lamb you shall offer at
evening. As the meal offering of the
morning, and as its drink offering, you
shall offer it, an offering made by fire, for
a pleasant aroma to Yahweh.
9 " 'On the Sabbath day, you shall offer
two male lambs a year old without defect,
and two tenths of an ephah† of fine flour
for a meal offering mixed with oil, and its
drink offering:
10 this is the burnt offering of every
Sabbath, in addition to the continual
burnt offering and its drink offering.
11 " 'In the beginnings of your months,
you shall offer a burnt offering to

† **28:5** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel ‡ **28:5** A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons. § **28:7** One hin is about 6.5 liters, so 1/4 hin is about 1.6 liters or 1.7 quarts. † **28:9** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

Yahweh: two young bulls, one ram, seven male lambs a year old without defect,
12 and three tenths of an ephah‡ of fine flour for a meal offering mixed with oil, for each bull; and two tenth parts of fine flour for a meal offering mixed with oil, for the one ram;
13 and one tenth part of fine flour mixed with oil for a meal offering to every lamb, as a burnt offering of a pleasant aroma, an offering made by fire to Yahweh.
14 Their drink offerings shall be half a hin of wine for a bull, the third part of a hin for the ram, and the fourth part of a hin for a lamb. This is the burnt offering of every month throughout the months of the year.
15 Also, one male goat for a sin offering to Yahweh shall be offered in addition to the continual burnt offering and its drink offering.

16 " 'In the first month, on the fourteenth day of the month, is Yahweh's Passover.
17 On the fifteenth day of this month shall be a feast. Unleavened bread shall be eaten for seven days.
18 In the first day shall be a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work,
19 but you shall offer an offering made by fire, a burnt offering to Yahweh: two young bulls, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old. They shall be without defect,
20 with their meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil. You shall offer three tenths for a bull, and two tenths for the ram.
21 You shall offer one tenth for every lamb of the seven lambs;
22 and one male goat for a sin offering, to make atonement for you.
23 You shall offer these in addition to the burnt offering of the morning, which is for a continual burnt offering.
24 In this way you shall offer daily, for seven days, the food of the offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma to Yahweh. It shall be offered in addition to the continual burnt offering and its drink offering.
25 On the seventh day you shall have a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work.
26 " 'Also in the day of the first fruits, when you offer a new meal offering to Yahweh in your feast of weeks, you shall have a holy convocation. You shall do no regular work;
27 but you shall offer a burnt offering for a pleasant aroma to Yahweh: two young bulls, one ram, seven male lambs a year old;
28 and their meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil, three tenths for each bull, two tenths for the one ram,
29 one tenth for every lamb of the seven lambs;
30 and one male goat, to make atonement for you.
31 Besides the continual burnt offering and its meal offering, you shall offer them and their drink offerings. See that they are without defect.

29

1 " 'In the seventh month, on the first day of the month, you shall have a holy convocation; you shall do no regular work. It is a day of blowing of trumpets to you.
2 You shall offer a burnt offering for a pleasant aroma to Yahweh: one young bull, one ram, seven male lambs a year old without defect;
3 and their meal offering, fine flour mixed with oil: three tenths for the bull, two tenths for the ram,
4 and one tenth for every lamb of the seven lambs;
5 and one male goat for a sin offering, to make atonement for you;
6 in addition to the burnt offering of the new moon with its meal offering, and the continual burnt offering with its meal offering, and their drink offerings, according to their ordinance, for a pleasant aroma, an offering made by fire to Yahweh.

‡ **28:12** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

7 “ ‘On the tenth day of this seventh
month you shall have a holy convocation.
You shall afflict your souls. You shall do
no kind of work;
8 but you shall offer a burnt offering to
Yahweh for a pleasant aroma: one young
bull, one ram, seven male lambs a year
old, all without defect;
9 and their meal offering, fine flour
mixed with oil: three tenths for the bull,
two tenths for the one ram,
10 one tenth for every lamb of the seven
lambs;
11 one male goat for a sin offering, in
addition to the sin offering of atonement,
and the continual burnt offering, and its
meal offering, and their drink offerings.
12 “ ‘On the fifteenth day of the seventh
month you shall have a holy convocation.
You shall do no regular work. You shall
keep a feast to Yahweh seven days.
13 You shall offer a burnt offering, an
offering made by fire, of a pleasant aroma
to Yahweh: thirteen young bulls, two
rams, fourteen male lambs a year old, all
without defect;
14 and their meal offering, fine flour
mixed with oil: three tenths for every bull
of the thirteen bulls, two tenths for each
ram of the two rams,
15 and one tenth for every lamb of the
fourteen lambs;
16 and one male goat for a sin offering,
in addition to the continual burnt
offering, its meal offering, and its drink
offering.
17 “ ‘On the second day you shall offer
twelve young bulls, two rams, and
fourteen male lambs a year old without
defect;
18 and their meal offering and their
drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams,
and for the lambs, according to their
number, after the ordinance;
19 and one male goat for a sin offering,
in addition to the continual burnt
offering, with its meal offering and their
drink offerings.
20 “ ‘On the third day: eleven bulls, two
rams, fourteen male lambs a year old
without defect;
21 and their meal offering and their
drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams,
and for the lambs, according to their
number, after the ordinance;
22 and one male goat for a sin offering,
in addition to the continual burnt
offering, and its meal offering, and its
drink offering.
23 “ ‘On the fourth day ten bulls, two
rams, fourteen male lambs a year old
without defect;
24 their meal offering and their drink
offerings for the bulls, for the rams, and
for the lambs, according to their number,
after the ordinance;
25 and one male goat for a sin offering;
in addition to the continual burnt
offering, its meal offering, and its drink
offering.
26 “ ‘On the fifth day: nine bulls, two
rams, fourteen male lambs a year old
without defect;
27 and their meal offering and their
drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams,
and for the lambs, according to their
number, after the ordinance,
28 and one male goat for a sin offering,
in addition to the continual burnt
offering, and its meal offering, and its
drink offering.
29 “ ‘On the sixth day: eight bulls, two
rams, fourteen male lambs a year old
without defect;
30 and their meal offering and their
drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams,
and for the lambs, according to their
number, after the ordinance,
31 and one male goat for a sin offering;
in addition to the continual burnt
offering, its meal offering, and the drink
offerings of it.
32 “ ‘On the seventh day: seven bulls,
two rams, fourteen male lambs a year old
without defect;
33 and their meal offering and their
drink offerings for the bulls, for the rams,
and for the lambs, according to their
number, after the ordinance,
34 and one male goat for a sin offering;
in addition to the continual burnt

offering, its meal offering, and its drink offering.
35 " 'On the eighth day you shall have a solemn assembly. You shall do no regular work;
36 but you shall offer a burnt offering, an offering made by fire, a pleasant aroma to Yahweh: one bull, one ram, seven male lambs a year old without defect;
37 their meal offering and their drink offerings for the bull, for the ram, and for the lambs, shall be according to their number, after the ordinance,
38 and one male goat for a sin offering, in addition to the continual burnt offering, with its meal offering, and its drink offering.
39 " 'You shall offer these to Yahweh in your set feasts—in addition to your vows and your free will offerings—for your burnt offerings, your meal offerings, your drink offerings, and your peace offerings.' "
40 Moses told the children of Israel according to all that Yahweh commanded Moses.

30

1 Moses spoke to the heads of the tribes of the children of Israel, saying, "This is the thing which Yahweh has commanded.
2 When a man vows a vow to Yahweh, or swears an oath to bind his soul with a bond, he shall not break his word. He shall do according to all that proceeds out of his mouth.
3 "Also, when a woman vows a vow to Yahweh and binds herself by a pledge, being in her father's house, in her youth,
4 and her father hears her vow and her pledge with which she has bound her soul, and her father says nothing to her, then all her vows shall stand, and every pledge with which she has bound her soul shall stand.
5 But if her father forbids her in the day that he hears, none of her vows or of her pledges with which she has bound her soul, shall stand. Yahweh will forgive her, because her father has forbidden her.
6 "If she has a husband, while her vows are on her, or the rash utterance of her lips with which she has bound her soul,
7 and her husband hears it, and says nothing to her in the day that he hears it; then her vows shall stand, and her pledges with which she has bound her soul shall stand.
8 But if her husband forbids her in the day that he hears it, then he makes void her vow which is on her and the rash utterance of her lips, with which she has bound her soul. Yahweh will forgive her.
9 "But the vow of a widow, or of her who is divorced, everything with which she has bound her soul shall stand against her.
10 "If she vowed in her husband's house or bound her soul by a bond with an oath,
11 and her husband heard it, and held his peace at her and didn't disallow her, then all her vows shall stand, and every pledge with which she bound her soul shall stand.
12 But if her husband made them null and void in the day that he heard them, then whatever proceeded out of her lips concerning her vows, or concerning the bond of her soul, shall not stand. Her husband has made them void. Yahweh will forgive her.
13 Every vow, and every binding oath to afflict the soul, her husband may establish it, or her husband may make it void.
14 But if her husband says nothing to her from day to day, then he establishes all her vows or all her pledges which are on her. He has established them, because he said nothing to her in the day that he heard them.
15 But if he makes them null and void after he has heard them, then he shall bear her iniquity."
16 These are the statutes which Yahweh commanded Moses, between a man and his wife, between a father and his daughter, being in her youth, in her father's house.

31

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 "Avenge the children of Israel on the Midianites. Afterward you shall be gathered to your people."
3 Moses spoke to the people, saying, "Arm men from among you for war, that

they may go against Midian, to execute Yahweh's vengeance on Midian.
4 You shall send one thousand out of every tribe, throughout all the tribes of Israel, to the war."
5 So there were delivered, out of the thousands of Israel, a thousand from every tribe, twelve thousand armed for war.
6 Moses sent them, one thousand of every tribe, to the war with Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest, to the war, with the vessels of the sanctuary and the trumpets for the alarm in his hand.
7 They fought against Midian, as Yahweh commanded Moses. They killed every male.
8 They killed the kings of Midian with the rest of their slain: Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba, the five kings of Midian. They also killed Balaam the son of Beor with the sword.
9 The children of Israel took the women of Midian captive with their little ones; and all their livestock, all their flocks, and all their goods, they took as plunder.
10 All their cities in the places in which they lived, and all their encampments, they burned with fire.
11 They took all the captives, and all the plunder, both of man and of animal.
12 They brought the captives with the prey and the plunder, to Moses, and to Eleazar the priest, and to the congregation of the children of Israel, to the camp at the plains of Moab, which are by the Jordan at Jericho.
13 Moses and Eleazar the priest, with all the princes of the congregation, went out to meet them outside of the camp.
14 Moses was angry with the officers of the army, the captains of thousands and the captains of hundreds, who came from the service of the war.
15 Moses said to them, "Have you saved all the women alive?
16 Behold, these caused the children of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to commit trespass against Yahweh in the matter of Peor, and so the plague was among the congregation of Yahweh.
17 Now therefore kill every male among the little ones, and kill every woman who has known man by lying with him.
18 But all the girls, who have not known man by lying with him, keep alive for yourselves.
19 "Encamp outside of the camp for seven days. Whoever has killed any person, and whoever has touched any slain, purify yourselves on the third day and on the seventh day, you and your captives.
20 You shall purify every garment, and all that is made of skin, and all work of goats' hair, and all things made of wood."
21 Eleazar the priest said to the men of war who went to the battle, "This is the statute of the law which Yahweh has commanded Moses.
22 However the gold, and the silver, the bronze, the iron, the tin, and the lead,
23 everything that may withstand the fire, you shall make to go through the fire, and it shall be clean; nevertheless it shall be purified with the water for impurity. All that doesn't withstand the fire you shall make to go through the water.
24 You shall wash your clothes on the seventh day, and you shall be clean. Afterward you shall come into the camp."
25 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
26 "Count the plunder that was taken, both of man and of animal, you, and Eleazar the priest, and the heads of the fathers' households of the congregation;
27 and divide the plunder into two parts: between the men skilled in war, who went out to battle, and all the congregation.
28 Levy a tribute to Yahweh of the men of war who went out to battle: one soul of five hundred; of the persons, of the cattle, of the donkeys, and of the flocks.
29 Take it from their half, and give it to Eleazar the priest, for Yahweh's wave offering.
30 Of the children of Israel's half, you shall take one drawn out of every fifty, of the persons, of the cattle, of the donkeys, and of the flocks, of all the livestock, and give them to the Levites, who perform the duty of Yahweh's tabernacle."

31 Moses and Eleazar the priest did as
Yahweh commanded Moses.
32 Now the plunder, over and above the
booty which the men of war took, was six
hundred seventy-five thousand sheep,
33 seventy-two thousand head of cattle,
34 sixty-one thousand donkeys,
35 and thirty-two thousand persons in
all, of the women who had not known
man by lying with him.
36 The half, which was the portion of
those who went out to war, was in
number three hundred thirty-seven
thousand five hundred sheep;
37 and Yahweh's tribute of the sheep
was six hundred seventy-five.
38 The cattle were thirty-six thousand, of
which Yahweh's tribute was seventy-two.
39 The donkeys were thirty thousand
five hundred, of which Yahweh's tribute
was sixty-one.
40 The persons were sixteen thousand,
of whom Yahweh's tribute was thirty-two
persons.
41 Moses gave the tribute, which was
Yahweh's wave offering, to Eleazar the
priest, as Yahweh commanded Moses.
42 Of the children of Israel's half, which
Moses divided off from the men who
fought
43 (now the congregation's half was
three hundred thirty-seven thousand five
hundred sheep,
44 thirty-six thousand head of cattle,
45 thirty thousand five hundred
donkeys,
46 and sixteen thousand persons),
47 even of the children of Israel's half,
Moses took one drawn out of every fifty,
both of man and of animal, and gave them
to the Levites, who performed the duty of
Yahweh's tabernacle, as Yahweh
commanded Moses.
48 The officers who were over the
thousands of the army, the captains of
thousands, and the captains of hundreds,
came near to Moses.
49 They said to Moses, "Your servants
have taken the sum of the men of war
who are under our command, and there
lacks not one man of us.
50 We have brought Yahweh's offering,
what every man found: gold ornaments,
armlets, bracelets, signet rings, earrings,
and necklaces, to make atonement for our
souls before Yahweh."
51 Moses and Eleazar the priest took
their gold, even all worked jewels.
52 All the gold of the wave offering that
they offered up to Yahweh, of the captains
of thousands, and of the captains of
hundreds, was sixteen thousand seven
hundred fifty shekels.†
53 The men of war had taken booty,
every man for himself.
54 Moses and Eleazar the priest took the
gold of the captains of thousands and of
hundreds, and brought it into the Tent of
Meeting for a memorial for the children
of Israel before Yahweh.

32

1 Now the children of Reuben and the
children of Gad had a very great
multitude of livestock. They saw the land
of Jazer, and the land of Gilead. Behold,
the place was a place for livestock.
2 Then the children of Gad and the
children of Reuben came and spoke to
Moses, and to Eleazar the priest, and to
the princes of the congregation, saying,
3 "Ataroth, Dibon, Jazer, Nimrah,
Heshbon, Elealeh, Sebam, Nebo, and
Beon,
4 the land which Yahweh struck before
the congregation of Israel, is a land for
livestock; and your servants have
livestock."
5 They said, "If we have found favor in
your sight, let this land be given to your
servants for a possession. Don't bring us
over the Jordan."
6 Moses said to the children of Gad, and
to the children of Reuben, "Shall your
brothers go to war while you sit here?
7 Why do you discourage the heart of
the children of Israel from going over into
the land which Yahweh has given them?

† **31:52** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 16,750 shekels is about 167.5 kilograms or about 368.5 pounds.

8 Your fathers did so when I sent them
from Kadesh Barnea to see the land.
9 For when they went up to the valley of
Eshcol, and saw the land, they
discouraged the heart of the children of
Israel, that they should not go into the
land which Yahweh had given them.
10 Yahweh's anger burned in that day,
and he swore, saying,
11 'Surely none of the men who came up
out of Egypt, from twenty years old and
upward, shall see the land which I swore
to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob;
because they have not wholly followed
me,
12 except Caleb the son of Jephunneh
the Kenizzite, and Joshua the son of Nun,
because they have followed Yahweh
completely.'
13 Yahweh's anger burned against
Israel, and he made them wander back
and forth in the wilderness forty years,
until all the generation who had done evil
in Yahweh's sight was consumed.
14 "Behold, you have risen up in your
fathers' place, an increase of sinful men,
to increase the fierce anger of Yahweh
toward Israel.
15 For if you turn away from after him,
he will yet again leave them in the
wilderness; and you will destroy all these
people."
16 They came near to him, and said, "We
will build sheepfolds here for our
livestock, and cities for our little ones;
17 but we ourselves will be ready armed
to go before the children of Israel, until
we have brought them to their place. Our
little ones shall dwell in the fortified cities
because of the inhabitants of the land.
18 We will not return to our houses until
the children of Israel have all received
their inheritance.
19 For we will not inherit with them on
the other side of the Jordan and beyond,
because our inheritance has come to us
on this side of the Jordan eastward."
20 Moses said to them: "If you will do
this thing, if you will arm yourselves to go
before Yahweh to the war,
21 and every one of your armed men
will pass over the Jordan before Yahweh
until he has driven out his enemies from
before him,
22 and the land is subdued before
Yahweh; then afterward you shall return,
and be clear of obligation to Yahweh and
to Israel. Then this land shall be your
possession before Yahweh.
23 "But if you will not do so, behold, you
have sinned against Yahweh; and be sure
your sin will find you out.
24 Build cities for your little ones, and
folds for your sheep; and do that which
has proceeded out of your mouth."
25 The children of Gad and the children
of Reuben spoke to Moses, saying, "Your
servants will do as my lord commands.
26 Our little ones, our wives, our flocks,
and all our livestock shall be there in the
cities of Gilead;
27 but your servants will pass over,
every man who is armed for war, before
Yahweh to battle, as my lord says."
28 So Moses commanded concerning
them to Eleazar the priest, and to Joshua
the son of Nun, and to the heads of the
fathers' households of the tribes of the
children of Israel.
29 Moses said to them, "If the children of
Gad and the children of Reuben will pass
with you over the Jordan, every man who
is armed to battle before Yahweh, and the
land is subdued before you, then you shall
give them the land of Gilead for a
possession;
30 but if they will not pass over with you
armed, they shall have possessions
among you in the land of Canaan."
31 The children of Gad and the children
of Reuben answered, saying, "As Yahweh
has said to your servants, so will we do.
32 We will pass over armed before
Yahweh into the land of Canaan, and the
possession of our inheritance shall
remain with us beyond the Jordan."
33 Moses gave to them, even to the
children of Gad, and to the children of
Reuben, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh
the son of Joseph, the kingdom of Sihon
king of the Amorites, and the kingdom of
Og king of Bashan; the land, according to
its cities and borders, even the cities of the
surrounding land.

34 The children of Gad built Dibon,
Ataroth, Aroer,
35 Atroth-shophan, Jazer, Jogbehah,
36 Beth Nimrah, and Beth Haran:
fortified cities and folds for sheep.
37 The children of Reuben built
Heshbon, Elealeh, Kiriathaim,
38 Nebo, and Baal Meon, (their names
being changed), and Sibmah. They gave
other names to the cities which they built.
39 The children of Machir the son of
Manasseh went to Gilead, took it, and
dispossessed the Amorites who were
therein.
40 Moses gave Gilead to Machir the son
of Manasseh; and he lived therein.
41 Jair the son of Manasseh went and
took its villages, and called them Havvoth
Jair.
42 Nobah went and took Kenath and its
villages, and called it Nobah, after his own
name.

33

1 These are the journeys of the children
of Israel, when they went out of the land
of Egypt by their armies under the hand
of Moses and Aaron.
2 Moses wrote the starting points of
their journeys by the commandment of
Yahweh. These are their journeys
according to their starting points.
3 They traveled from Rameses in the
first month, on the fifteenth day of the first
month; on the next day after the Passover,
the children of Israel went out with a high
hand in the sight of all the Egyptians,
4 while the Egyptians were burying all
their firstborn, whom Yahweh had struck
among them. Yahweh also executed
judgments on their gods.
5 The children of Israel traveled from
Rameses, and encamped in Succoth.
6 They traveled from Succoth, and
encamped in Etham, which is in the edge
of the wilderness.
7 They traveled from Etham, and turned
back to Pihahiroth, which is before Baal
Zephon, and they encamped before
Migdol.
8 They traveled from before Hahiroth,
and crossed through the middle of the sea
into the wilderness. They went three days'
journey in the wilderness of Etham, and
encamped in Marah.
9 They traveled from Marah, and came
to Elim. In Elim, there were twelve
springs of water and seventy palm trees,
and they encamped there.
10 They traveled from Elim, and
encamped by the Red Sea.
11 They traveled from the Red Sea, and
encamped in the wilderness of Sin.
12 They traveled from the wilderness of
Sin, and encamped in Dophkah.
13 They traveled from Dophkah, and
encamped in Alush.
14 They traveled from Alush, and
encamped in Rephidim, where there was
no water for the people to drink.
15 They traveled from Rephidim, and
encamped in the wilderness of Sinai.
16 They traveled from the wilderness of
Sinai, and encamped in Kibroth
Hattaavah.
17 They traveled from Kibroth
Hattaavah, and encamped in Hazeroth.
18 They traveled from Hazeroth, and
encamped in Rithmah.
19 They traveled from Rithmah, and
encamped in Rimmon Perez.
20 They traveled from Rimmon Perez,
and encamped in Libnah.
21 They traveled from Libnah, and
encamped in Rissah.
22 They traveled from Rissah, and
encamped in Kehelathah.
23 They traveled from Kehelathah, and
encamped in Mount Shepher.
24 They traveled from Mount Shepher,
and encamped in Haradah.
25 They traveled from Haradah, and
encamped in Makheloth.
26 They traveled from Makheloth, and
encamped in Tahath.
27 They traveled from Tahath, and
encamped in Terah.
28 They traveled from Terah, and
encamped in Mithkah.
29 They traveled from Mithkah, and
encamped in Hashmonah.
30 They traveled from Hashmonah, and
encamped in Moseroth.

31 They traveled from Moseroth, and
encamped in Bene Jaakan.
32 They traveled from Bene Jaakan, and
encamped in Hor Haggidgad.
33 They traveled from Hor Haggidgad,
and encamped in Jotbathah.
34 They traveled from Jotbathah, and
encamped in Abronah.
35 They traveled from Abronah, and
encamped in Ezion Geber.
36 They traveled from Ezion Geber, and
encamped at Kadesh in the wilderness of
Zin.
37 They traveled from Kadesh, and
encamped in Mount Hor, in the edge of
the land of Edom.
38 Aaron the priest went up into Mount
Hor at the commandment of Yahweh and
died there, in the fortieth year after the
children of Israel had come out of the land
of Egypt, in the fifth month, on the first
day of the month.
39 Aaron was one hundred twenty-three
years old when he died in Mount Hor.
40 The Canaanite king of Arad, who lived
in the South in the land of Canaan, heard
of the coming of the children of Israel.
41 They traveled from Mount Hor, and
encamped in Zalmonah.
42 They traveled from Zalmonah, and
encamped in Punon.
43 They traveled from Punon, and
encamped in Oboth.
44 They traveled from Oboth, and
encamped in Iye Abarim, in the border of
Moab.
45 They traveled from Iyim, and
encamped in Dibon Gad.
46 They traveled from Dibon Gad, and
encamped in Almon Diblathaim.
47 They traveled from Almon
Diblathaim, and encamped in the
mountains of Abarim, before Nebo.
48 They traveled from the mountains of
Abarim, and encamped in the plains of
Moab by the Jordan at Jericho.
49 They encamped by the Jordan, from
Beth Jeshimoth even to Abel Shittim in the
plains of Moab.
50 Yahweh spoke to Moses in the plains
of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho, saying,
51 Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them, “When you pass over the Jordan
into the land of Canaan,
52 then you shall drive out all the
inhabitants of the land from before you,
destroy all their stone idols, destroy all
their molten images, and demolish all
their high places.
53 You shall take possession of the land,
and dwell therein; for I have given the
land to you to possess it.
54 You shall inherit the land by lot
according to your families; to the larger
groups you shall give a larger inheritance,
and to the smaller you shall give a smaller
inheritance. Wherever the lot falls to any
man, that shall be his. You shall inherit
according to the tribes of your fathers.
55 “But if you do not drive out the
inhabitants of the land from before you,
then those you let remain of them will be
like pricks in your eyes and thorns in your
sides. They will harass you in the land in
which you dwell.
56 It shall happen that as I thought to do
to them, so I will do to you.”

34

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
2 “Command the children of Israel, and
tell them, ‘When you come into the land of
Canaan (this is the land that shall fall to
you for an inheritance, even the land of
Canaan according to its borders),
3 then your south quarter shall be from
the wilderness of Zin along by the side of
Edom, and your south border shall be
from the end of the Salt Sea eastward.
4 Your border shall turn about
southward of the ascent of Akrabbim, and
pass along to Zin; and it shall pass
southward of Kadesh Barnea; and it shall
go from there to Hazar Addar, and pass
along to Azmon.
5 The border shall turn about from
Azmon to the brook of Egypt, and it shall
end at the sea.
6 “ ‘For the western border, you shall
have the great sea and its border. This
shall be your west border.

7 “ ‘This shall be your north border:
from the great sea you shall mark out for
yourselves Mount Hor.
8 From Mount Hor you shall mark out to
the entrance of Hamath; and the border
shall pass by Zedad.
9 Then the border shall go to Ziphron,
and it shall end at Hazar Enan. This shall
be your north border.
10 “ ‘You shall mark out your east border
from Hazar Enan to Shepham.
11 The border shall go down from
Shepham to Riblah, on the east side of Ain.
The border shall go down, and shall reach
to the side of the sea of Chinnereth
eastward.
12 The border shall go down to the
Jordan, and end at the Salt Sea. This shall
be your land according to its borders
around it.’ ”
13 Moses commanded the children of
Israel, saying, “This is the land which you
shall inherit by lot, which Yahweh has
commanded to give to the nine tribes, and
to the half-tribe;
14 for the tribe of the children of Reuben
according to their fathers’ houses, the
tribe of the children of Gad according to
their fathers’ houses, and the half-tribe of
Manasseh have received their
inheritance.
15 The two tribes and the half-tribe have
received their inheritance beyond the
Jordan at Jericho eastward, toward the
sunrise.”
16 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
17 “These are the names of the men who
shall divide the land to you for
inheritance: Eleazar the priest, and
Joshua the son of Nun.
18 You shall take one prince of every
tribe, to divide the land for inheritance.
19 These are the names of the men: Of
the tribe of Judah, Caleb the son of
Jephunneh.
20 Of the tribe of the children of Simeon,
Shemuel the son of Ammihud.
21 Of the tribe of Benjamin, Elidad the
son of Chislon.
22 Of the tribe of the children of Dan a
prince, Bukki the son of Jogli.
23 Of the children of Joseph: of the tribe
of the children of Manasseh a prince,
Hanniel the son of Ephod.
24 Of the tribe of the children of Ephraim
a prince, Kemuel the son of Shiphtan.
25 Of the tribe of the children of Zebulun
a prince, Elizaphan the son of Parnach.
26 Of the tribe of the children of Issachar
a prince, Paltiel the son of Azzan.
27 Of the tribe of the children of Asher a
prince, Ahihud the son of Shelomi.
28 Of the tribe of the children of Naphtali
a prince, Pedahel the son of Ammihud.”
29 These are they whom Yahweh
commanded to divide the inheritance to
the children of Israel in the land of
Canaan.

35

1 Yahweh spoke to Moses in the plains of
Moab by the Jordan at Jericho, saying,
2 “Command the children of Israel to
give to the Levites cities to dwell in out of
their inheritance. You shall give pasture
lands for the cities around them to the
Levites.
3 They shall have the cities to dwell in.
Their pasture lands shall be for their
livestock, and for their possessions, and
for all their animals.
4 “The pasture lands of the cities, which
you shall give to the Levites, shall be from
the wall of the city and outward one
thousand cubits† around it.
5 You shall measure outside of the city
for the east side two thousand cubits, and
for the south side two thousand cubits,
and for the west side two thousand cubits,
and for the north side two thousand
cubits, the city being in the middle. This
shall be the pasture lands of their cities.
6 “The cities which you shall give to the
Levites, they shall be the six cities of
refuge, which you shall give for the man
slayer to flee to. Besides them you shall
give forty-two cities.
7 All the cities which you shall give to
the Levites shall be forty-eight cities
together with their pasture lands.
8 Concerning the cities which you shall
give of the possession of the children of

† **35:4** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

Israel, from the many you shall take
many, and from the few you shall take
few. Everyone according to his
inheritance which he inherits shall give
some of his cities to the Levites."
9 Yahweh spoke to Moses, saying,
10 "Speak to the children of Israel, and
tell them, 'When you pass over the Jordan
into the land of Canaan,
11 then you shall appoint for yourselves
cities to be cities of refuge for you, that the
man slayer who kills any person
unwittingly may flee there.
12 The cities shall be for your refuge
from the avenger, that the man slayer not
die until he stands before the
congregation for judgment.
13 The cities which you shall give shall
be for you six cities of refuge.
14 You shall give three cities beyond the
Jordan, and you shall give three cities in
the land of Canaan. They shall be cities of
refuge.
15 These six cities shall be refuge for the
children of Israel, for the stranger, and for
the foreigner living among them, that
everyone who kills any person
unwittingly may flee there.
16 " 'But if he struck him with an
instrument of iron, so that he died, he is a
murderer. The murderer shall surely be
put to death.
17 If he struck him with a stone in the
hand, by which a man may die, and he
died, he is a murderer. The murderer
shall surely be put to death.
18 Or if he struck him with a weapon of
wood in the hand, by which a man may
die, and he died, he is a murderer. The
murderer shall surely be put to death.
19 The avenger of blood shall himself
put the murderer to death. When he
meets him, he shall put him to death.
20 If he shoved him out of hatred, or
hurled something at him while lying in
wait, so that he died,
21 or in hostility struck him with his
hand, so that he died, he who struck him
shall surely be put to death. He is a
murderer. The avenger of blood shall put
the murderer to death when he meets
him.
22 " 'But if he shoved him suddenly
without hostility, or hurled on him
anything without lying in wait,
23 or with any stone, by which a man
may die, not seeing him, and cast it on him
so that he died, and he was not his enemy
and not seeking his harm,
24 then the congregation shall judge
between the striker and the avenger of
blood according to these ordinances.
25 The congregation shall deliver the
man slayer out of the hand of the avenger
of blood, and the congregation shall
restore him to his city of refuge, where he
had fled. He shall dwell therein until the
death of the high priest, who was
anointed with the holy oil.
26 " 'But if the man slayer shall at any
time go beyond the border of his city of
refuge where he flees,
27 and the avenger of blood finds him
outside of the border of his city of refuge,
and the avenger of blood kills the man
slayer, he shall not be guilty of blood,
28 because he should have remained in
his city of refuge until the death of the
high priest. But after the death of the high
priest, the man slayer shall return into the
land of his possession.
29 " 'These things shall be for a statute
and ordinance to you throughout your
generations in all your dwellings.
30 " 'Whoever kills any person, the
murderer shall be slain based on the
testimony of witnesses; but one witness
shall not testify alone against any person
so that he dies.
31 " 'Moreover you shall take no ransom
for the life of a murderer who is guilty of
death. He shall surely be put to death.
32 " 'You shall take no ransom for him
who has fled to his city of refuge, that he
may come again to dwell in the land
before the death of the priest.
33 " 'So you shall not pollute the land
where you live; for blood pollutes the
land. No atonement can be made for the
land for the blood that is shed in it, but by
the blood of him who shed it.

34 You shall not defile the land which
you inhabit, where I dwell; for I, Yahweh,
dwell among the children of Israel.' "

36

1 The heads of the fathers' households of
the family of the children of Gilead, the
son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, of the
families of the sons of Joseph, came near
and spoke before Moses and before the
princes, the heads of the fathers'
households of the children of Israel.
2 They said, "Yahweh commanded my
lord to give the land for inheritance by lot
to the children of Israel. My lord was
commanded by Yahweh to give the
inheritance of Zelophehad our brother to
his daughters.
3 If they are married to any of the sons
of the other tribes of the children of Israel,
then their inheritance will be taken away
from the inheritance of our fathers, and
will be added to the inheritance of the
tribe to which they shall belong. So it will
be taken away from the lot of our
inheritance.
4 When the jubilee of the children of
Israel comes, then their inheritance will
be added to the inheritance of the tribe to
which they shall belong. So their
inheritance will be taken away from the
inheritance of the tribe of our fathers."
5 Moses commanded the children of
Israel according to Yahweh's word,
saying, "The tribe of the sons of Joseph
speak what is right.
6 This is the thing which Yahweh
commands concerning the daughters of
Zelophehad, saying, 'Let them be married
to whom they think best, only they shall
marry into the family of the tribe of their
father.
7 So shall no inheritance of the children
of Israel move from tribe to tribe; for the
children of Israel shall all keep the
inheritance of the tribe of his fathers.
8 Every daughter who possesses an
inheritance in any tribe of the children of
Israel shall be wife to one of the family of
the tribe of her father, that the children of
Israel may each possess the inheritance of
his fathers.
9 So shall no inheritance move from one
tribe to another tribe; for the tribes of the
children of Israel shall each keep his own
inheritance.' "
10 The daughters of Zelophehad did as
Yahweh commanded Moses:
11 for Mahlah, Tirzah, Hoglah, Milcah,
and Noah, the daughters of Zelophehad,
were married to their father's brothers'
sons.
12 They were married into the families
of the sons of Manasseh the son of Joseph.
Their inheritance remained in the tribe of
the family of their father.
13 These are the commandments and the
ordinances which Yahweh commanded
by Moses to the children of Israel in the
plains of Moab by the Jordan at Jericho.

The Fifth Book of Moses, Commonly Called Deuteronomy

1 These are the words which Moses
spoke to all Israel beyond the Jordan in
the wilderness, in the Arabah opposite
Suf, between Paran, Tophel, Laban,
Hazeroth, and Dizahab.
2 It is eleven days' journey from Horeb
by the way of Mount Seir to Kadesh
Barnea.
3 In the fortieth year, in the eleventh
month, on the first day of the month,
Moses spoke to the children of Israel
according to all that Yahweh† had given
him in commandment to them,
4 after he had struck Sihon the king of
the Amorites who lived in Heshbon, and
Og the king of Bashan who lived in
Ashtaroth, at Edrei.
5 Beyond the Jordan, in the land of
Moab, Moses began to declare this law,
saying,
6 "Yahweh our God‡ spoke to us in
Horeb, saying, 'You have lived long
enough at this mountain.
7 Turn, and take your journey, and go to
the hill country of the Amorites and to all
the places near there: in the Arabah, in
the hill country, in the lowland, in the
South, by the seashore, in the land of the
Canaanites, and in Lebanon as far as the
great river, the river Euphrates.
8 Behold,§ I have set the land before
you. Go in and possess the land which
Yahweh swore to your fathers—to
Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob—to give to
them and to their offspring† after them.' "
9 I spoke to you at that time, saying, "I
am not able to bear you myself alone.
10 Yahweh your God has multiplied you,
and behold, you are today as the stars of
the sky for multitude.
11 May Yahweh, the God of your fathers,
make you a thousand times as many as
you are and bless you, as he has promised
you!
12 How can I myself alone bear your
problems, your burdens, and your strife?
13 Take wise men of understanding who
are respected among your tribes, and I
will make them heads over you."
14 You answered me, and said, "The
thing which you have spoken is good to
do."
15 So I took the heads of your tribes,
wise and respected men, and made them
heads over you, captains of thousands,
captains of hundreds, captains of fifties,
captains of tens, and officers, according to
your tribes.
16 I commanded your judges at that
time, saying, "Hear cases between your
brothers and judge righteously between a
man and his brother, and the foreigner
who is living with him.
17 You shall not show partiality in
judgment; you shall hear the small and
the great alike. You shall not be afraid of
the face of man, for the judgment is God's.
The case that is too hard for you, you shall
bring to me, and I will hear it."
18 I commanded you at that time all the
things which you should do.
19 We traveled from Horeb and went
through all that great and terrible
wilderness which you saw, by the way to
the hill country of the Amorites, as
Yahweh our God commanded us; and we
came to Kadesh Barnea.
20 I said to you, "You have come to the
hill country of the Amorites, which
Yahweh our God gives to us.
21 Behold, Yahweh your God has set the
land before you. Go up, take possession,
as Yahweh the God of your fathers has
spoken to you. Don't be afraid, neither be
dismayed."
22 You came near to me, everyone of
you, and said, "Let's send men before us,
that they may search the land for us, and
bring back to us word of the way by which

† **1:3** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:6** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). § **1:8** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. † **1:8** or, seed

we must go up, and the cities to which we shall come."
23 The thing pleased me well. I took twelve of your men, one man for every tribe.
24 They turned and went up into the hill country, and came to the valley of Eshcol, and spied it out.
25 They took some of the fruit of the land in their hands and brought it down to us, and brought us word again, and said, "It is a good land which Yahweh our God gives to us."
26 Yet you wouldn't go up, but rebelled against the commandment of Yahweh your God.
27 You murmured in your tents, and said, "Because Yahweh hated us, he has brought us out of the land of Egypt, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites to destroy us.
28 Where are we going up? Our brothers have made our heart melt, saying, 'The people are greater and taller than we. The cities are great and fortified up to the sky. Moreover we have seen the sons of the Anakim there!' "
29 Then I said to you, "Don't be terrified. Don't be afraid of them.
30 Yahweh your God, who goes before you, he will fight for you, according to all that he did for you in Egypt before your eyes,
31 and in the wilderness where you have seen how that Yahweh your God carried you, as a man carries his son, in all the way that you went, until you came to this place."
32 Yet in this thing you didn't believe Yahweh your God,
33 who went before you on the way, to seek out a place for you to pitch your tents in: in fire by night, to show you by what way you should go, and in the cloud by day.
34 Yahweh heard the voice of your words and was angry, and swore, saying,
35 "Surely not one of these men of this evil generation shall see the good land which I swore to give to your fathers,
36 except Caleb the son of Jephunneh. He shall see it. I will give the land that he has trodden on to him and to his children, because he has wholly followed Yahweh."
37 Also Yahweh was angry with me for your sakes, saying, "You also shall not go in there.
38 Joshua the son of Nun, who stands before you, shall go in there. Encourage him, for he shall cause Israel to inherit it.
39 Moreover your little ones, whom you said would be captured or killed, your children, who today have no knowledge of good or evil, shall go in there. I will give it to them, and they shall possess it.
40 But as for you, turn, and take your journey into the wilderness by the way to the Red Sea."
41 Then you answered and said to me, "We have sinned against Yahweh. We will go up and fight, according to all that Yahweh our God commanded us." Every man of you put on his weapons of war, and presumed to go up into the hill country.
42 Yahweh said to me, "Tell them, 'Don't go up and don't fight; for I am not among you, lest you be struck before your enemies.' "
43 So I spoke to you, and you didn't listen; but you rebelled against the commandment of Yahweh, and were presumptuous, and went up into the hill country.
44 The Amorites, who lived in that hill country, came out against you and chased you as bees do, and beat you down in Seir, even to Hormah.
45 You returned and wept before Yahweh, but Yahweh didn't listen to your voice, nor turn his ear to you.
46 So you stayed in Kadesh many days, according to the days that you remained.

2

1 Then we turned, and took our journey into the wilderness by the way to the Red Sea, as Yahweh spoke to me; and we encircled Mount Seir many days.
2 Yahweh spoke to me, saying,
3 "You have encircled this mountain long enough. Turn northward.
4 Command the people, saying, 'You are to pass through the border of your

brothers, the children of Esau, who dwell in Seir; and they will be afraid of you. Therefore be careful.
5 Don't contend with them; for I will not give you any of their land, no, not so much as for the sole of the foot to tread on, because I have given Mount Seir to Esau for a possession.
6 You shall purchase food from them for money, that you may eat. You shall also buy water from them for money, that you may drink.' "
7 For Yahweh your God has blessed you in all the work of your hands. He has known your walking through this great wilderness. These forty years, Yahweh your God has been with you. You have lacked nothing.
8 So we passed by from our brothers, the children of Esau, who dwell in Seir, from the way of the Arabah from Elath and from Ezion Geber. We turned and passed by the way of the wilderness of Moab.
9 Yahweh said to me, "Don't bother Moab, neither contend with them in battle; for I will not give you any of his land for a possession, because I have given Ar to the children of Lot for a possession."
10 (The Emim lived there before, a great and numerous people, and tall as the Anakim.
11 These also are considered to be Rephaim, as the Anakim; but the Moabites call them Emim.
12 The Horites also lived in Seir in the past, but the children of Esau succeeded them. They destroyed them from before them, and lived in their place, as Israel did to the land of his possession, which Yahweh gave to them.)
13 "Now rise up and cross over the brook Zered." We went over the brook Zered.
14 The days in which we came from Kadesh Barnea until we had come over the brook Zered were thirty-eight years, until all the generation of the men of war were consumed from the middle of the camp, as Yahweh swore to them.
15 Moreover Yahweh's hand was against them, to destroy them from the middle of the camp, until they were consumed.
16 So, when all the men of war were consumed and dead from among the people,
17 Yahweh spoke to me, saying,
18 "You are to pass over Ar, the border of Moab, today.
19 When you come near the border of the children of Ammon, don't bother them, nor contend with them; for I will not give you any of the land of the children of Ammon for a possession, because I have given it to the children of Lot for a possession."
20 (That also is considered a land of Rephaim. Rephaim lived there in the past, but the Ammonites call them Zamzummim,
21 a great people, many, and tall, as the Anakim; but Yahweh destroyed them from before Israel, and they succeeded them, and lived in their place,
22 as he did for the children of Esau who dwell in Seir, when he destroyed the Horites from before them; and they succeeded them, and lived in their place even to this day.
23 Then the Avvim, who lived in villages as far as Gaza: the Caphtorim, who came out of Caphtor, destroyed them and lived in their place.)
24 "Rise up, take your journey, and pass over the valley of the Arnon. Behold, I have given into your hand Sihon the Amorite, king of Heshbon, and his land; begin to possess it, and contend with him in battle.
25 Today I will begin to put the dread of you and the fear of you on the peoples who are under the whole sky, who shall hear the report of you, and shall tremble and be in anguish because of you."
26 I sent messengers out of the wilderness of Kedemoth to Sihon king of Heshbon with words of peace, saying,
27 "Let me pass through your land. I will go along by the highway. I will turn neither to the right hand nor to the left.
28 You shall sell me food for money, that I may eat; and give me water for money, that I may drink. Just let me pass through on my feet,

29 as the children of Esau who dwell in Seir, and the Moabites who dwell in Ar, did to me, until I pass over the Jordan into the land which Yahweh our God gives us."
30 But Sihon king of Heshbon would not let us pass by him, for Yahweh your God hardened his spirit and made his heart obstinate, that he might deliver him into your hand, as it is today.
31 Yahweh said to me, "Behold, I have begun to deliver up Sihon and his land before you. Begin to possess, that you may inherit his land."
32 Then Sihon came out against us, he and all his people, to battle at Jahaz.
33 Yahweh our God delivered him up before us; and we struck him, his sons, and all his people.
34 We took all his cities at that time, and utterly destroyed every inhabited city, with the women and the little ones. We left no one remaining.
35 Only the livestock we took for plunder for ourselves, with the plunder of the cities which we had taken.
36 From Aroer, which is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in the valley, even to Gilead, there was not a city too high for us. Yahweh our God delivered up all before us.
37 Only to the land of the children of Ammon you didn't come near: all the banks of the river Jabbok, and the cities of the hill country, and wherever Yahweh our God forbade us.

3

1 Then we turned, and went up the way to Bashan. Og the king of Bashan came out against us, he and all his people, to battle at Edrei.
2 Yahweh said to me, "Don't fear him; for I have delivered him, with all his people and his land, into your hand. You shall do to him as you did to Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon."
3 So Yahweh our God also delivered into our hand Og, the king of Bashan, and all his people. We struck him until no one was left to him remaining.
4 We took all his cities at that time. There was not a city which we didn't take from them: sixty cities, all the region of Argob, the kingdom of Og in Bashan.
5 All these were cities fortified with high walls, gates, and bars, in addition to a great many villages without walls.
6 We utterly destroyed them, as we did to Sihon king of Heshbon, utterly destroying every inhabited city, with the women and the little ones.
7 But all the livestock, and the plunder of the cities, we took for plunder for ourselves.
8 We took the land at that time out of the hand of the two kings of the Amorites who were beyond the Jordan, from the valley of the Arnon to Mount Hermon.
9 (The Sidonians call Hermon Sirion, and the Amorites call it Senir.)
10 We took all the cities of the plain, and all Gilead, and all Bashan, to Salecah and Edrei, cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan.
11 (For only Og king of Bashan remained of the remnant of the Rephaim. Behold, his bedstead was a bedstead of iron. Isn't it in Rabbah of the children of Ammon? Nine cubits† was its length, and four cubits its width, after the cubit of a man.)
12 This land we took in possession at that time: from Aroer, which is by the valley of the Arnon, and half the hill country of Gilead with its cities, I gave to the Reubenites and to the Gadites;
13 and the rest of Gilead, and all Bashan, the kingdom of Og, I gave to the half-tribe of Manasseh—all the region of Argob, even all Bashan. (The same is called the land of Rephaim.
14 Jair the son of Manasseh took all the region of Argob, to the border of the Geshurites and the Maacathites, and called them, even Bashan, after his own name, Havvoth Jair, to this day.)
15 I gave Gilead to Machir.
16 To the Reubenites and to the Gadites I gave from Gilead even to the valley of the Arnon, the middle of the valley, and its border, even to the river Jabbok, which is the border of the children of Ammon;

† **3:11** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

17 the Arabah also, and the Jordan and
its border, from Chinnereth even to the
sea of the Arabah, the Salt Sea, under the
slopes of Pisgah eastward.
18 I commanded you at that time, saying,
“Yahweh your God has given you this land
to possess it. All of you men of valor shall
pass over armed before your brothers, the
children of Israel.
19 But your wives, and your little ones,
and your livestock, (I know that you have
much livestock), shall live in your cities
which I have given you,
20 until Yahweh gives rest to your
brothers, as to you, and they also possess
the land which Yahweh your God gives
them beyond the Jordan. Then you shall
each return to his own possession, which I
have given you.”
21 I commanded Joshua at that time,
saying, “Your eyes have seen all that
Yahweh your God has done to these two
kings. So shall Yahweh do to all the
kingdoms where you go over.
22 You shall not fear them; for Yahweh
your God himself fights for you.”
23 I begged Yahweh at that time, saying,
24 “Lord‡ Yahweh, you have begun to
show your servant your greatness, and
your strong hand. For what god is there in
heaven or in earth that can do works like
yours, and mighty acts like yours?
25 Please let me go over and see the good
land that is beyond the Jordan, that fine
mountain, and Lebanon.”
26 But Yahweh was angry with me
because of you, and didn’t listen to me.
Yahweh said to me, “That is enough!
Speak no more to me of this matter.
27 Go up to the top of Pisgah, and lift up
your eyes westward, and northward, and
southward, and eastward, and see with
your eyes; for you shall not go over this
Jordan.
28 But commission Joshua, and
encourage him, and strengthen him; for
he shall go over before this people, and he
shall cause them to inherit the land which
you shall see.”
29 So we stayed in the valley near Beth
Peor.

4

1 Now, Israel, listen to the statutes and to
the ordinances which I teach you, to do
them, that you may live and go in and
possess the land which Yahweh, the God
of your fathers, gives you.
2 You shall not add to the word which I
command you, neither shall you take
away from it, that you may keep the
commandments of Yahweh your God
which I command you.
3 Your eyes have seen what Yahweh did
because of Baal Peor; for Yahweh your
God has destroyed all the men who
followed Baal Peor from among you.
4 But you who were faithful to Yahweh
your God are all alive today.
5 Behold, I have taught you statutes and
ordinances, even as Yahweh my God
commanded me, that you should do so in
the middle of the land where you go in to
possess it.
6 Keep therefore and do them; for this is
your wisdom and your understanding in
the sight of the peoples who shall hear all
these statutes and say, “Surely this great
nation is a wise and understanding
people.”
7 For what great nation is there that has
a god so near to them as Yahweh our God
is whenever we call on him?
8 What great nation is there that has
statutes and ordinances so righteous as all
this law which I set before you today?
9 Only be careful, and keep your soul
diligently, lest you forget the things which
your eyes saw, and lest they depart from
your heart all the days of your life; but
make them known to your children and
your children’s children—
10 the day that you stood before Yahweh
your God in Horeb, when Yahweh said to
me, “Assemble the people to me, and I will
make them hear my words, that they may
learn to fear me all the days that they live
on the earth, and that they may teach
their children.”

‡ **3:24** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai.”

11 You came near and stood under the mountain. The mountain burned with fire to the heart of the sky, with darkness, cloud, and thick darkness.
12 Yahweh spoke to you out of the middle of the fire: you heard the voice of words, but you saw no form; you only heard a voice.
13 He declared to you his covenant, which he commanded you to perform, even the ten commandments. He wrote them on two stone tablets.
14 Yahweh commanded me at that time to teach you statutes and ordinances, that you might do them in the land where you go over to possess it.
15 Be very careful, for you saw no kind of form on the day that Yahweh spoke to you in Horeb out of the middle of the fire,
16 lest you corrupt yourselves, and make yourself a carved image in the form of any figure, the likeness of male or female,
17 the likeness of any animal that is on the earth, the likeness of any winged bird that flies in the sky,
18 the likeness of anything that creeps on the ground, the likeness of any fish that is in the water under the earth;
19 and lest you lift up your eyes to the sky, and when you see the sun and the moon and the stars, even all the army of the sky, you are drawn away and worship them, and serve them, which Yahweh your God has allotted to all the peoples under the whole sky.
20 But Yahweh has taken you, and brought you out of the iron furnace, out of Egypt, to be to him a people of inheritance, as it is today.
21 Furthermore Yahweh was angry with me for your sakes, and swore that I should not go over the Jordan, and that I should not go in to that good land which Yahweh your God gives you for an inheritance;
22 but I must die in this land. I must not go over the Jordan, but you shall go over and possess that good land.
23 Be careful, lest you forget the covenant of Yahweh your God, which he made with you, and make yourselves a carved image in the form of anything which Yahweh your God has forbidden you.
24 For Yahweh your God is a devouring fire, a jealous God.
25 When you father children and children's children, and you have been long in the land, and then corrupt yourselves, and make a carved image in the form of anything, and do that which is evil in Yahweh your God's sight to provoke him to anger,
26 I call heaven and earth to witness against you today, that you will soon utterly perish from off the land which you go over the Jordan to possess it. You will not prolong your days on it, but will utterly be destroyed.
27 Yahweh will scatter you among the peoples, and you will be left few in number among the nations where Yahweh will lead you away.
28 There you will serve gods, the work of men's hands, wood and stone, which neither see, nor hear, nor eat, nor smell.
29 But from there you shall seek Yahweh your God, and you will find him when you search after him with all your heart and with all your soul.
30 When you are in oppression, and all these things have come on you, in the latter days you shall return to Yahweh your God and listen to his voice.
31 For Yahweh your God is a merciful God. He will not fail you nor destroy you, nor forget the covenant of your fathers which he swore to them.
32 For ask now of the days that are past, which were before you, since the day that God created man on the earth, and from the one end of the sky to the other, whether there has been anything as great as this thing is, or has been heard like it?
33 Did a people ever hear the voice of God speaking out of the middle of the fire, as you have heard, and live?
34 Or has God tried to go and take a nation for himself from among another nation, by trials, by signs, by wonders, by war, by a mighty hand, by an outstretched arm, and by great terrors, according to all that Yahweh your God did for you in

Egypt before your eyes?
35 It was shown to you so that you might know that Yahweh is God. There is no one else besides him.
36 Out of heaven he made you to hear his voice, that he might instruct you. On earth he made you to see his great fire; and you heard his words out of the middle of the fire.
37 Because he loved your fathers, therefore he chose their offspring after them, and brought you out with his presence, with his great power, out of Egypt;
38 to drive out nations from before you greater and mightier than you, to bring you in, to give you their land for an inheritance, as it is today.
39 Know therefore today, and take it to heart, that Yahweh himself is God in heaven above and on the earth beneath. There is no one else.
40 You shall keep his statutes and his commandments which I command you today, that it may go well with you and with your children after you, and that you may prolong your days in the land which Yahweh your God gives you for all time.

41 Then Moses set apart three cities beyond the Jordan toward the sunrise,
42 that the man slayer might flee there, who kills his neighbor unintentionally and didn't hate him in time past, and that fleeing to one of these cities he might live:
43 Bezer in the wilderness, in the plain country, for the Reubenites; and Ramoth in Gilead for the Gadites; and Golan in Bashan for the Manassites.
44 This is the law which Moses set before the children of Israel.
45 These are the testimonies, and the statutes, and the ordinances which Moses spoke to the children of Israel when they came out of Egypt,
46 beyond the Jordan, in the valley opposite Beth Peor, in the land of Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived at Heshbon, whom Moses and the children of Israel struck when they came out of Egypt.
47 They took possession of his land and the land of Og king of Bashan, the two kings of the Amorites, who were beyond the Jordan toward the sunrise;
48 from Aroer, which is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, even to Mount Siyon (also called Hermon),
49 and all the Arabah beyond the Jordan eastward, even to the sea of the Arabah, under the slopes of Pisgah.

5

1 Moses called to all Israel, and said to them, "Hear, Israel, the statutes and the ordinances which I speak in your ears today, that you may learn them, and observe to do them."
2 Yahweh our God made a covenant with us in Horeb.
3 Yahweh didn't make this covenant with our fathers, but with us, even us, who are all of us here alive today.
4 Yahweh spoke with you face to face on the mountain out of the middle of the fire,
5 (I stood between Yahweh and you at that time, to show you Yahweh's word; for you were afraid because of the fire, and didn't go up onto the mountain) saying,
6 "I am Yahweh your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage.

7 "You shall have no other gods before me.
8 "You shall not make a carved image for yourself—any likeness of what is in heaven above, or what is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth.
9 You shall not bow yourself down to them, nor serve them, for I, Yahweh your God, am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity of the fathers on the children and on the third and on the fourth generation of those who hate me
10 and showing loving kindness to thousands of those who love me and keep my commandments.

11 "You shall not misuse the name of Yahweh your God;† for Yahweh will not hold him guiltless who misuses his name.

† **5:11** or, You shall not take the name of Yahweh your God in vain;

12 “Observe the Sabbath day, to keep it
holy, as Yahweh your God commanded
you.
13 You shall labor six days, and do all
your work;
14 but the seventh day is a Sabbath to
Yahweh your God, in which you shall not
do any work—neither you, nor your son,
nor your daughter, nor your male servant,
nor your female servant, nor your ox, nor
your donkey, nor any of your livestock,
nor your stranger who is within your
gates; that your male servant and your
female servant may rest as well as you.
15 You shall remember that you were a
servant in the land of Egypt, and Yahweh
your God brought you out of there by a
mighty hand and by an outstretched arm.
Therefore Yahweh your God commanded
you to keep the Sabbath day.
16 “Honor your father and your mother,
as Yahweh your God commanded you,
that your days may be long and that it
may go well with you in the land which
Yahweh your God gives you.
17 “You shall not murder.
18 “You shall not commit adultery.
19 “You shall not steal.
20 “You shall not give false testimony
against your neighbor.
21 “You shall not covet your neighbor’s
wife. Neither shall you desire your
neighbor’s house, his field, or his male
servant, or his female servant, his ox, or
his donkey, or anything that is your
neighbor’s.”
22 Yahweh spoke these words to all your
assembly on the mountain out of the
middle of the fire, of the cloud, and of the
thick darkness, with a great voice. He
added no more. He wrote them on two
stone tablets, and gave them to me.
23 When you heard the voice out of the
middle of the darkness, while the
mountain was burning with fire, you
came near to me, even all the heads of
your tribes, and your elders;
24 and you said, “Behold, Yahweh our
God has shown us his glory and his
greatness, and we have heard his voice
out of the middle of the fire. We have seen
today that God does speak with man, and
he lives.
25 Now therefore, why should we die?
For this great fire will consume us. If we
hear Yahweh our God’s voice any more,
then we shall die.
26 For who is there of all flesh who has
heard the voice of the living God speaking
out of the middle of the fire, as we have,
and lived?
27 Go near, and hear all that Yahweh our
God shall say, and tell us all that Yahweh
our God tells you; and we will hear it, and
do it.”
28 Yahweh heard the voice of your
words when you spoke to me; and
Yahweh said to me, “I have heard the
voice of the words of this people which
they have spoken to you. They have well
said all that they have spoken.
29 Oh that there were such a heart in
them that they would fear me and keep all
my commandments always, that it might
be well with them and with their children
forever!
30 “Go tell them, ‘Return to your tents.’
31 But as for you, stand here by me, and I
will tell you all the commandments, and
the statutes, and the ordinances, which
you shall teach them, that they may do
them in the land which I give them to
possess.”
32 You shall observe to do therefore as
Yahweh your God has commanded you.
You shall not turn away to the right hand
or to the left.
33 You shall walk in all the way which
Yahweh your God has commanded you,
that you may live and that it may be well
with you, and that you may prolong your
days in the land which you shall possess.

6

1 Now these are the commandments,
the statutes, and the ordinances, which
Yahweh your God commanded to teach
you, that you might do them in the land
that you go over to possess;
2 that you might fear Yahweh your God,
to keep all his statutes and his
commandments, which I command
you—you, your son, and your son’s son, all

the days of your life; and that your days may be prolonged.
3 Hear therefore, Israel, and observe to do it, that it may be well with you, and that you may increase mightily, as Yahweh, the God of your fathers, has promised to you, in a land flowing with milk and honey.
4 Hear, Israel: Yahweh is our God. Yahweh is one.
5 You shall love Yahweh your God with all your heart, with all your soul, and with all your might.
6 These words, which I command you today, shall be on your heart;
7 and you shall teach them diligently to your children, and shall talk of them when you sit in your house, and when you walk by the way, and when you lie down, and when you rise up.
8 You shall bind them for a sign on your hand, and they shall be for frontlets between your eyes.
9 You shall write them on the door posts of your house and on your gates.
10 It shall be, when Yahweh your God brings you into the land which he swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, to give you, great and goodly cities which you didn't build,
11 and houses full of all good things which you didn't fill, and cisterns dug out which you didn't dig, vineyards and olive trees which you didn't plant, and you shall eat and be full;
12 then beware lest you forget Yahweh, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage.
13 You shall fear Yahweh your God; and you shall serve him, and shall swear by his name.
14 You shall not go after other gods, of the gods of the peoples who are around you,
15 for Yahweh your God among you is a jealous God, lest the anger of Yahweh your God be kindled against you, and he destroy you from off the face of the earth.
16 You shall not tempt Yahweh your God, as you tempted him in Massah.
17 You shall diligently keep the commandments of Yahweh your God, and his testimonies, and his statutes, which he has commanded you.
18 You shall do that which is right and good in Yahweh's sight, that it may be well with you and that you may go in and possess the good land which Yahweh swore to your fathers,
19 to thrust out all your enemies from before you, as Yahweh has spoken.
20 When your son asks you in time to come, saying, "What do the testimonies, the statutes, and the ordinances, which Yahweh our God has commanded you mean?"
21 then you shall tell your son, "We were Pharaoh's slaves in Egypt. Yahweh brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand;
22 and Yahweh showed great and awesome signs and wonders on Egypt, on Pharaoh, and on all his house, before our eyes;
23 and he brought us out from there, that he might bring us in, to give us the land which he swore to our fathers.
24 Yahweh commanded us to do all these statutes, to fear Yahweh our God, for our good always, that he might preserve us alive, as we are today.
25 It shall be righteousness to us, if we observe to do all these commandments before Yahweh our God, as he has commanded us."

7

1 When Yahweh your God brings you into the land where you go to possess it, and casts out many nations before you—the Hittite, the Girgashite, the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite—seven nations greater and mightier than you;
2 and when Yahweh your God delivers them up before you, and you strike them, then you shall utterly destroy them. You shall make no covenant with them, nor show mercy to them.
3 You shall not make marriages with them. You shall not give your daughter to his son, nor shall you take his daughter for your son.

4 For that would turn away your sons
from following me, that they may serve
other gods. So Yahweh's anger would be
kindled against you, and he would destroy
you quickly.
5 But you shall deal with them like this:
you shall break down their altars, dash
their pillars in pieces, cut down their
Asherah poles, and burn their engraved
images with fire.
6 For you are a holy people to Yahweh
your God. Yahweh your God has chosen
you to be a people for his own possession,
above all peoples who are on the face of
the earth.
7 Yahweh didn't set his love on you nor
choose you, because you were more in
number than any people; for you were the
fewest of all peoples;
8 but because Yahweh loves you, and
because he desires to keep the oath which
he swore to your fathers, Yahweh has
brought you out with a mighty hand and
redeemed you out of the house of
bondage, from the hand of Pharaoh king
of Egypt.
9 Know therefore that Yahweh your God
himself is God, the faithful God, who
keeps covenant and loving kindness to a
thousand generations with those who
love him and keep his commandments,
10 and repays those who hate him to
their face, to destroy them. He will not be
slack to him who hates him. He will repay
him to his face.
11 You shall therefore keep the
commandments, the statutes, and the
ordinances which I command you today,
to do them.
12 It shall happen, because you listen to
these ordinances and keep and do them,
that Yahweh your God will keep with you
the covenant and the loving kindness
which he swore to your fathers.
13 He will love you, bless you, and
multiply you. He will also bless the fruit of
your body and the fruit of your ground,
your grain and your new wine and your
oil, the increase of your livestock and the
young of your flock, in the land which he
swore to your fathers to give you.
14 You will be blessed above all peoples.
There won't be male or female barren
among you, or among your livestock.
15 Yahweh will take away from you all
sickness; and he will put none of the evil
diseases of Egypt, which you know, on
you, but will lay them on all those who
hate you.
16 You shall consume all the peoples
whom Yahweh your God shall deliver to
you. Your eye shall not pity them. You
shall not serve their gods; for that would
be a snare to you.
17 If you shall say in your heart, "These
nations are more than I; how can I
dispossess them?"
18 you shall not be afraid of them. You
shall remember well what Yahweh your
God did to Pharaoh and to all Egypt:
19 the great trials which your eyes saw,
the signs, the wonders, the mighty hand,
and the outstretched arm, by which
Yahweh your God brought you out. So
shall Yahweh your God do to all the
peoples of whom you are afraid.
20 Moreover Yahweh your God will send
the hornet among them, until those who
are left, and hide themselves, perish from
before you.
21 You shall not be scared of them; for
Yahweh your God is among you, a great
and awesome God.
22 Yahweh your God will cast out those
nations before you little by little. You may
not consume them at once, lest the
animals of the field increase on you.
23 But Yahweh your God will deliver
them up before you, and will confuse
them with a great confusion, until they
are destroyed.
24 He will deliver their kings into your
hand, and you shall make their name
perish from under the sky. No one will be
able to stand before you until you have
destroyed them.
25 You shall burn the engraved images
of their gods with fire. You shall not covet
the silver or the gold that is on them, nor
take it for yourself, lest you be snared in
it; for it is an abomination to Yahweh your
God.

26 You shall not bring an abomination into your house and become a devoted thing like it. You shall utterly detest it. You shall utterly abhor it; for it is a devoted thing.

8

1 You shall observe to do all the commandments which I command you today, that you may live, and multiply, and go in and possess the land which Yahweh swore to your fathers.
2 You shall remember all the way which Yahweh your God has led you these forty years in the wilderness, that he might humble you, to test you, to know what was in your heart, whether you would keep his commandments or not.
3 He humbled you, allowed you to be hungry, and fed you with manna, which you didn't know, neither did your fathers know, that he might teach you that man does not live by bread only, but man lives by every word that proceeds out of Yahweh's mouth.
4 Your clothing didn't grow old on you, neither did your foot swell, these forty years.
5 You shall consider in your heart that as a man disciplines his son, so Yahweh your God disciplines you.
6 You shall keep the commandments of Yahweh your God, to walk in his ways, and to fear him.
7 For Yahweh your God brings you into a good land, a land of brooks of water, of springs, and underground water flowing into valleys and hills;
8 a land of wheat, barley, vines, fig trees, and pomegranates; a land of olive trees and honey;
9 a land in which you shall eat bread without scarcity, you shall not lack anything in it; a land whose stones are iron, and out of whose hills you may dig copper.
10 You shall eat and be full, and you shall bless Yahweh your God for the good land which he has given you.
11 Beware lest you forget Yahweh your God, in not keeping his commandments, his ordinances, and his statutes, which I command you today;
12 lest, when you have eaten and are full, and have built fine houses and lived in them;
13 and when your herds and your flocks multiply, and your silver and your gold is multiplied, and all that you have is multiplied;
14 then your heart might be lifted up, and you forget Yahweh your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage;
15 who led you through the great and terrible wilderness, with venomous snakes and scorpions, and thirsty ground where there was no water; who poured water for you out of the rock of flint;
16 who fed you in the wilderness with manna, which your fathers didn't know, that he might humble you, and that he might prove you, to do you good at your latter end;
17 and lest you say in your heart, "My power and the might of my hand has gotten me this wealth."
18 But you shall remember Yahweh your God, for it is he who gives you power to get wealth, that he may establish his covenant which he swore to your fathers, as it is today.
19 It shall be, if you shall forget Yahweh your God, and walk after other gods, and serve them and worship them, I testify against you today that you shall surely perish.
20 As the nations that Yahweh makes to perish before you, so you shall perish, because you wouldn't listen to Yahweh your God's voice.

9

1 Hear, Israel! You are to pass over the Jordan today, to go in to dispossess nations greater and mightier than yourself, cities great and fortified up to the sky,
2 a people great and tall, the sons of the Anakim, whom you know, and of whom you have heard say, "Who can stand before the sons of Anak?"

3 Know therefore today that Yahweh your God is he who goes over before you as a devouring fire. He will destroy them and he will bring them down before you. So you shall drive them out and make them perish quickly, as Yahweh has spoken to you.

4 Don't say in your heart, after Yahweh your God has thrust them out from before you, "For my righteousness Yahweh has brought me in to possess this land;" because Yahweh drives them out before you because of the wickedness of these nations.
5 Not for your righteousness or for the uprightness of your heart do you go in to possess their land; but for the wickedness of these nations Yahweh your God does drive them out from before you, and that he may establish the word which Yahweh swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob.
6 Know therefore that Yahweh your God doesn't give you this good land to possess for your righteousness, for you are a stiff-necked people.
7 Remember, and don't forget, how you provoked Yahweh your God to wrath in the wilderness. From the day that you left the land of Egypt until you came to this place, you have been rebellious against Yahweh.
8 Also in Horeb you provoked Yahweh to wrath, and Yahweh was angry with you to destroy you.
9 When I had gone up onto the mountain to receive the stone tablets, even the tablets of the covenant which Yahweh made with you, then I stayed on the mountain forty days and forty nights. I neither ate bread nor drank water.
10 Yahweh delivered to me the two stone tablets written with God's finger. On them were all the words which Yahweh spoke with you on the mountain out of the middle of the fire in the day of the assembly.

11 It came to pass at the end of forty days and forty nights that Yahweh gave me the two stone tablets, even the tablets of the covenant.

12 Yahweh said to me, "Arise, get down quickly from here; for your people whom you have brought out of Egypt have corrupted themselves. They have quickly turned away from the way which I commanded them. They have made a molten image for themselves!"

13 Furthermore Yahweh spoke to me, saying, "I have seen these people, and behold, they are a stiff-necked people.
14 Leave me alone, that I may destroy them, and blot out their name from under the sky; and I will make of you a nation mightier and greater than they."
15 So I turned and came down from the mountain, and the mountain was burning with fire. The two tablets of the covenant were in my two hands.
16 I looked, and behold, you had sinned against Yahweh your God. You had made yourselves a molded calf. You had quickly turned away from the way which Yahweh had commanded you.
17 I took hold of the two tablets, and threw them out of my two hands, and broke them before your eyes.
18 I fell down before Yahweh, as at the first, forty days and forty nights. I neither ate bread nor drank water, because of all your sin which you sinned, in doing that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, to provoke him to anger.
19 For I was afraid of the anger and hot displeasure with which Yahweh was angry against you to destroy you. But Yahweh listened to me that time also.
20 Yahweh was angry enough with Aaron to destroy him. I prayed for Aaron also at the same time.
21 I took your sin, the calf which you had made, and burned it with fire, and crushed it, grinding it very small, until it was as fine as dust. I threw its dust into the brook that descended out of the mountain.
22 At Taberah, at Massah, and at Kibroth Hattaavah you provoked Yahweh to wrath.
23 When Yahweh sent you from Kadesh Barnea, saying, "Go up and possess the land which I have given you," you rebelled against the commandment of

Yahweh your God, and you didn't believe him or listen to his voice.
24 You have been rebellious against Yahweh from the day that I knew you.
25 So I fell down before Yahweh the forty days and forty nights that I fell down, because Yahweh had said he would destroy you.
26 I prayed to Yahweh, and said, "Lord Yahweh, don't destroy your people and your inheritance that you have redeemed through your greatness, that you have brought out of Egypt with a mighty hand.
27 Remember your servants, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Don't look at the stubbornness of this people, nor at their wickedness, nor at their sin,
28 lest the land you brought us out from say, 'Because Yahweh was not able to bring them into the land which he promised to them, and because he hated them, he has brought them out to kill them in the wilderness.'
29 Yet they are your people and your inheritance, which you brought out by your great power and by your outstretched arm."

10

1 At that time Yahweh said to me, "Cut two stone tablets like the first, and come up to me onto the mountain, and make an ark of wood.
2 I will write on the tablets the words that were on the first tablets which you broke, and you shall put them in the ark."
3 So I made an ark of acacia wood, and cut two stone tablets like the first, and went up onto the mountain, having the two tablets in my hand.
4 He wrote on the tablets, according to the first writing, the ten commandments, which Yahweh spoke to you on the mountain out of the middle of the fire in the day of the assembly; and Yahweh gave them to me.
5 I turned and came down from the mountain, and put the tablets in the ark which I had made; and there they are as Yahweh commanded me.
6 (The children of Israel traveled from Beeroth Bene Jaakan to Moserah. There Aaron died, and there he was buried; and Eleazar his son ministered in the priest's office in his place.
7 From there they traveled to Gudgodah; and from Gudgodah to Jotbathah, a land of brooks of water.
8 At that time Yahweh set apart the tribe of Levi to bear the ark of Yahweh's covenant, to stand before Yahweh to minister to him, and to bless in his name, to this day.
9 Therefore Levi has no portion nor inheritance with his brothers; Yahweh is his inheritance, according as Yahweh your God spoke to him.)
10 I stayed on the mountain, as at the first time, forty days and forty nights; and Yahweh listened to me that time also. Yahweh would not destroy you.
11 Yahweh said to me, "Arise, take your journey before the people; and they shall go in and possess the land which I swore to their fathers to give to them."
12 Now, Israel, what does Yahweh your God require of you, but to fear Yahweh your God, to walk in all his ways, to love him, and to serve Yahweh your God with all your heart and with all your soul,
13 to keep Yahweh's commandments and statutes, which I command you today for your good?
14 Behold, to Yahweh your God belongs heaven, the heaven of heavens, and the earth, with all that is therein.
15 Only Yahweh had a delight in your fathers to love them, and he chose their offspring after them, even you above all peoples, as it is today.
16 Circumcise therefore the foreskin of your heart, and be no more stiff-necked.
17 For Yahweh your God, he is God of gods and Lord of lords, the great God, the mighty, and the awesome, who doesn't respect persons or take bribes.
18 He executes justice for the fatherless and widow and loves the foreigner in giving him food and clothing.
19 Therefore love the foreigner, for you were foreigners in the land of Egypt.
20 You shall fear Yahweh your God. You shall serve him. You shall cling to him, and you shall swear by his name.

21 He is your praise, and he is your God,
who has done for you these great and
awesome things which your eyes have
seen.
22 Your fathers went down into Egypt
with seventy persons; and now Yahweh
your God has made you as the stars of the
sky for multitude.

11

1 Therefore you shall love Yahweh your
God, and keep his instructions, his
statutes, his ordinances, and his
commandments, always.
2 Know this day—for I don't speak with
your children who have not known, and
who have not seen the chastisement of
Yahweh your God, his greatness, his
mighty hand, his outstretched arm,
3 his signs, and his works, which he did
in the middle of Egypt to Pharaoh the king
of Egypt, and to all his land;
4 and what he did to the army of Egypt,
to their horses, and to their chariots; how
he made the water of the Red Sea to
overflow them as they pursued you, and
how Yahweh has destroyed them to this
day;
5 and what he did to you in the
wilderness until you came to this place;
6 and what he did to Dathan and
Abiram, the sons of Eliab, the son of
Reuben—how the earth opened its mouth
and swallowed them up, with their
households, their tents, and every living
thing that followed them, in the middle of
all Israel;
7 but your eyes have seen all of
Yahweh's great work which he did.
8 Therefore you shall keep the entire
commandment which I command you
today, that you may be strong, and go in
and possess the land that you go over to
possess;
9 and that you may prolong your days in
the land which Yahweh swore to your
fathers to give to them and to their
offspring, a land flowing with milk and
honey.
10 For the land, where you go in to
possess isn't like the land of Egypt that
you came out of, where you sowed your
seed and watered it with your foot, as a
garden of herbs;
11 but the land that you go over to
possess is a land of hills and valleys which
drinks water from the rain of the sky,
12 a land which Yahweh your God cares
for. Yahweh your God's eyes are always
on it, from the beginning of the year even
to the end of the year.
13 It shall happen, if you shall listen
diligently to my commandments which I
command you today, to love Yahweh your
God, and to serve him with all your heart
and with all your soul,
14 that I will give the rain for your land
in its season, the early rain and the latter
rain, that you may gather in your grain,
your new wine, and your oil.
15 I will give grass in your fields for your
livestock, and you shall eat and be full.
16 Be careful, lest your heart be
deceived, and you turn away to serve
other gods and worship them;
17 and Yahweh's anger be kindled
against you, and he shut up the sky so that
there is no rain, and the land doesn't yield
its fruit; and you perish quickly from off
the good land which Yahweh gives you.
18 Therefore you shall lay up these
words of mine in your heart and in your
soul. You shall bind them for a sign on
your hand, and they shall be for frontlets
between your eyes.
19 You shall teach them to your children,
talking of them when you sit in your
house, when you walk by the way, when
you lie down, and when you rise up.
20 You shall write them on the door
posts of your house and on your gates;
21 that your days and your children's
days may be multiplied in the land which
Yahweh swore to your fathers to give
them, as the days of the heavens above
the earth.
22 For if you shall diligently keep all
these commandments which I command
you—to do them, to love Yahweh your
God, to walk in all his ways, and to cling to
him—
23 then Yahweh will drive out all these
nations from before you, and you shall

dispossess nations greater and mightier than yourselves.
24 Every place on which the sole of your foot treads shall be yours: from the wilderness and Lebanon, from the river, the river Euphrates, even to the western sea shall be your border.
25 No man will be able to stand before you. Yahweh your God will lay the fear of you and the dread of you on all the land that you tread on, as he has spoken to you.
26 Behold, I set before you today a blessing and a curse:
27 the blessing, if you listen to the commandments of Yahweh your God, which I command you today;
28 and the curse, if you do not listen to the commandments of Yahweh your God, but turn away out of the way which I command you today, to go after other gods which you have not known.
29 It shall happen, when Yahweh your God brings you into the land that you go to possess, that you shall set the blessing on Mount Gerizim, and the curse on Mount Ebal.
30 Aren't they beyond the Jordan, behind the way of the going down of the sun, in the land of the Canaanites who dwell in the Arabah near Gilgal, beside the oaks of Moreh?
31 For you are to pass over the Jordan to go in to possess the land which Yahweh your God gives you, and you shall possess it and dwell in it.
32 You shall observe to do all the statutes and the ordinances which I set before you today.

12

1 These are the statutes and the ordinances which you shall observe to do in the land which Yahweh, the God of your fathers, has given you to possess all the days that you live on the earth.
2 You shall surely destroy all the places in which the nations that you shall dispossess served their gods: on the high mountains, and on the hills, and under every green tree.
3 You shall break down their altars, dash their pillars in pieces, and burn their Asherah poles with fire. You shall cut down the engraved images of their gods. You shall destroy their name out of that place.
4 You shall not do so to Yahweh your God.
5 But to the place which Yahweh your God shall choose out of all your tribes, to put his name there, you shall seek his habitation, and you shall come there.
6 You shall bring your burnt offerings, your sacrifices, your tithes, the wave offering of your hand, your vows, your free will offerings, and the firstborn of your herd and of your flock there.
7 There you shall eat before Yahweh your God, and you shall rejoice in all that you put your hand to, you and your households, in which Yahweh your God has blessed you.
8 You shall not do all the things that we do here today, every man whatever is right in his own eyes;
9 for you haven't yet come to the rest and to the inheritance which Yahweh your God gives you.
10 But when you go over the Jordan and dwell in the land which Yahweh your God causes you to inherit, and he gives you rest from all your enemies around you, so that you dwell in safety,
11 then it shall happen that to the place which Yahweh your God shall choose, to cause his name to dwell there, there you shall bring all that I command you: your burnt offerings, your sacrifices, your tithes, the wave offering of your hand, and all your choice vows which you vow to Yahweh.
12 You shall rejoice before Yahweh your God—you, and your sons, your daughters, your male servants, your female servants, and the Levite who is within your gates, because he has no portion nor inheritance with you.
13 Be careful that you don't offer your burnt offerings in every place that you see;
14 but in the place which Yahweh chooses in one of your tribes, there you shall offer your burnt offerings, and there

you shall do all that I command you.
15 Yet you may kill and eat meat within
all your gates, after all the desire of your
soul, according to Yahweh your God's
blessing which he has given you. The
unclean and the clean may eat of it, as of
the gazelle and the deer.
16 Only you shall not eat the blood. You
shall pour it out on the earth like water.
17 You may not eat within your gates the
tithe of your grain, or of your new wine, or
of your oil, or the firstborn of your herd or
of your flock, nor any of your vows which
you vow, nor your free will offerings, nor
the wave offering of your hand;
18 but you shall eat them before Yahweh
your God in the place which Yahweh your
God shall choose: you, your son, your
daughter, your male servant, your female
servant, and the Levite who is within your
gates. You shall rejoice before Yahweh
your God in all that you put your hand to.
19 Be careful that you don't forsake the
Levite as long as you live in your land.
20 When Yahweh your God enlarges
your border, as he has promised you, and
you say, "I want to eat meat," because
your soul desires to eat meat, you may eat
meat, after all the desire of your soul.
21 If the place which Yahweh your God
shall choose to put his name is too far
from you, then you shall kill of your herd
and of your flock, which Yahweh has
given you, as I have commanded you; and
you may eat within your gates, after all
the desire of your soul.
22 Even as the gazelle and as the deer is
eaten, so you shall eat of it. The unclean
and the clean may eat of it alike.
23 Only be sure that you don't eat the
blood; for the blood is the life. You shall
not eat the life with the meat.
24 You shall not eat it. You shall pour it
out on the earth like water.
25 You shall not eat it, that it may go well
with you and with your children after
you, when you do that which is right in
Yahweh's eyes.
26 Only your holy things which you
have, and your vows, you shall take and
go to the place which Yahweh shall
choose.
27 You shall offer your burnt offerings,
the meat and the blood, on Yahweh your
God's altar. The blood of your sacrifices
shall be poured out on Yahweh your God's
altar, and you shall eat the meat.
28 Observe and hear all these words
which I command you, that it may go well
with you and with your children after you
forever, when you do that which is good
and right in Yahweh your God's eyes.
29 When Yahweh your God cuts off the
nations from before you where you go in
to dispossess them, and you dispossess
them and dwell in their land,
30 be careful that you are not ensnared
to follow them after they are destroyed
from before you, and that you not inquire
after their gods, saying, "How do these
nations serve their gods? I will do
likewise."
31 You shall not do so to Yahweh your
God; for every abomination to Yahweh,
which he hates, they have done to their
gods; for they even burn their sons and
their daughters in the fire to their gods.
32 Whatever thing I command you, that
you shall observe to do. You shall not add
to it, nor take away from it.

13

1 If a prophet or a dreamer of dreams
arises among you, and he gives you a sign
or a wonder,
2 and the sign or the wonder comes to
pass, of which he spoke to you, saying,
"Let's go after other gods" (which you
have not known) "and let's serve them,"
3 you shall not listen to the words of that
prophet, or to that dreamer of dreams; for
Yahweh your God is testing you, to know
whether you love Yahweh your God with
all your heart and with all your soul.
4 You shall walk after Yahweh your God,
fear him, keep his commandments, and
obey his voice. You shall serve him, and
cling to him.
5 That prophet, or that dreamer of
dreams, shall be put to death, because he
has spoken rebellion against Yahweh your

God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt and redeemed you out of the house of bondage, to draw you aside out of the way which Yahweh your God commanded you to walk in. So you shall remove the evil from among you.

6 If your brother, the son of your mother, or your son, or your daughter, or the wife of your bosom, or your friend who is as your own soul, entices you secretly, saying, “Let’s go and serve other gods”—which you have not known, you, nor your fathers;
7 of the gods of the peoples who are around you, near to you, or far off from you, from the one end of the earth even to the other end of the earth—
8 you shall not consent to him nor listen to him; neither shall your eye pity him, neither shall you spare, neither shall you conceal him;
9 but you shall surely kill him. Your hand shall be first on him to put him to death, and afterwards the hands of all the people.
10 You shall stone him to death with stones, because he has sought to draw you away from Yahweh your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage.
11 All Israel shall hear, and fear, and shall not do any more wickedness like this among you.

12 If you hear about one of your cities, which Yahweh your God gives you to dwell there, that
13 certain wicked fellows have gone out from among you and have drawn away the inhabitants of their city, saying, “Let’s go and serve other gods,” which you have not known,
14 then you shall inquire, investigate, and ask diligently. Behold, if it is true, and the thing certain, that such abomination was done among you,
15 you shall surely strike the inhabitants of that city with the edge of the sword, destroying it utterly, with all that is therein and its livestock, with the edge of the sword.
16 You shall gather all its plunder into the middle of its street, and shall burn with fire the city, with all of its plunder, to Yahweh your God. It shall be a heap forever. It shall not be built again.
17 Nothing of the devoted thing shall cling to your hand, that Yahweh may turn from the fierceness of his anger and show you mercy, and have compassion on you and multiply you, as he has sworn to your fathers,
18 when you listen to Yahweh your God’s voice, to keep all his commandments which I command you today, to do that which is right in Yahweh your God’s eyes.

14

1 You are the children of Yahweh your God. You shall not cut yourselves, nor make any baldness between your eyes for the dead.
2 For you are a holy people to Yahweh your God, and Yahweh has chosen you to be a people for his own possession, above all peoples who are on the face of the earth.
3 You shall not eat any abominable thing.
4 These are the animals which you may eat: the ox, the sheep, the goat,
5 the deer, the gazelle, the roebuck, the wild goat, the ibex, the antelope, and the chamois.
6 Every animal that parts the hoof, and has the hoof split in two and chews the cud, among the animals, you may eat.
7 Nevertheless these you shall not eat of them that chew the cud, or of those who have the hoof split: the camel, the hare, and the rabbit. Because they chew the cud but don’t part the hoof, they are unclean to you.
8 The pig, because it has a split hoof but doesn’t chew the cud, is unclean to you. You shall not eat their meat. You shall not touch their carcasses.
9 These you may eat of all that are in the waters: you may eat whatever has fins and scales.
10 You shall not eat whatever doesn’t have fins and scales. It is unclean to you.
11 Of all clean birds you may eat.

12 But these are they of which you shall
not eat: the eagle, the vulture, the osprey,
13 the red kite, the falcon, the kite of any
kind,
14 every raven of any kind,
15 the ostrich, the owl, the seagull, the
hawk of any kind,
16 the little owl, the great owl, the
horned owl,
17 the pelican, the vulture, the
cormorant,
18 the stork, the heron after its kind, the
hoopoe, and the bat.
19 All winged creeping things are
unclean to you. They shall not be eaten.
20 Of all clean birds you may eat.
21 You shall not eat of anything that dies
of itself. You may give it to the foreigner
living among you who is within your
gates, that he may eat it; or you may sell it
to a foreigner; for you are a holy people to
Yahweh your God.

You shall not boil a young goat in its
mother's milk.
22 You shall surely tithe all the increase
of your seed, that which comes out of the
field year by year.
23 You shall eat before Yahweh your
God, in the place which he chooses to
cause his name to dwell, the tithe of your
grain, of your new wine, and of your oil,
and the firstborn of your herd and of your
flock; that you may learn to fear Yahweh
your God always.
24 If the way is too long for you, so that
you are not able to carry it because the
place which Yahweh your God shall
choose to set his name there is too far
from you, when Yahweh your God blesses
you,
25 then you shall turn it into money,
bind up the money in your hand, and
shall go to the place which Yahweh your
God shall choose.
26 You shall trade the money for
whatever your soul desires: for cattle, or
for sheep, or for wine, or for strong drink,
or for whatever your soul asks of you. You
shall eat there before Yahweh your God,
and you shall rejoice, you and your
household.
27 You shall not forsake the Levite who
is within your gates, for he has no portion
nor inheritance with you.
28 At the end of every three years you
shall bring all the tithe of your increase in
the same year, and shall store it within
your gates.
29 The Levite, because he has no portion
nor inheritance with you, as well as the
foreigner living among you, the
fatherless, and the widow who are within
your gates shall come, and shall eat and
be satisfied; that Yahweh your God may
bless you in all the work of your hand
which you do.

15

1 At the end of every seven years, you
shall cancel debts.
2 This is the way it shall be done: every
creditor shall release that which he has
lent to his neighbor. He shall not require
payment from his neighbor and his
brother, because Yahweh's release has
been proclaimed.
3 Of a foreigner you may require it; but
whatever of yours is with your brother,
your hand shall release.
4 However there will be no poor with
you (for Yahweh will surely bless you in
the land which Yahweh your God gives
you for an inheritance to possess)
5 if only you diligently listen to Yahweh
your God's voice, to observe to do all this
commandment which I command you
today.
6 For Yahweh your God will bless you, as
he promised you. You will lend to many
nations, but you will not borrow. You will
rule over many nations, but they will not
rule over you.
7 If a poor man, one of your brothers, is
with you within any of your gates in your
land which Yahweh your God gives you,
you shall not harden your heart, nor shut
your hand from your poor brother;
8 but you shall surely open your hand to
him, and shall surely lend him sufficient
for his need, which he lacks.
9 Beware that there not be a wicked
thought in your heart, saying, "The

seventh year, the year of release, is at hand," and your eye be evil against your poor brother and you give him nothing; and he cry to Yahweh against you, and it be sin to you.
10 You shall surely give, and your heart shall not be grieved when you give to him, because it is for this thing Yahweh your God will bless you in all your work and in all that you put your hand to.
11 For the poor will never cease out of the land. Therefore I command you to surely open your hand to your brother, to your needy, and to your poor, in your land.
12 If your brother, a Hebrew man, or a Hebrew woman, is sold to you and serves you six years, then in the seventh year you shall let him go free from you.
13 When you let him go free from you, you shall not let him go empty.
14 You shall furnish him liberally out of your flock, out of your threshing floor, and out of your wine press. As Yahweh your God has blessed you, you shall give to him.
15 You shall remember that you were a slave in the land of Egypt, and Yahweh your God redeemed you. Therefore I command you this thing today.
16 It shall be, if he tells you, "I will not go out from you," because he loves you and your house, because he is well with you,
17 then you shall take an awl, and thrust it through his ear to the door, and he shall be your servant forever. Also to your female servant you shall do likewise.
18 It shall not seem hard to you when you let him go free from you, for he has been double the value of a hired hand as he served you six years. Yahweh your God will bless you in all that you do.
19 You shall dedicate all the firstborn males that are born of your herd and of your flock to Yahweh your God. You shall do no work with the firstborn of your herd, nor shear the firstborn of your flock.
20 You shall eat it before Yahweh your God year by year in the place which Yahweh shall choose, you and your household.
21 If it has any defect—is lame or blind, or has any defect whatever, you shall not sacrifice it to Yahweh your God.
22 You shall eat it within your gates. The unclean and the clean shall eat it alike, as the gazelle and as the deer.
23 Only you shall not eat its blood. You shall pour it out on the ground like water.

16

1 Observe the month of Abib, and keep the Passover to Yahweh your God; for in the month of Abib Yahweh your God brought you out of Egypt by night.
2 You shall sacrifice the Passover to Yahweh your God, of the flock and the herd, in the place which Yahweh shall choose to cause his name to dwell there.
3 You shall eat no leavened bread with it. You shall eat unleavened bread with it seven days, even the bread of affliction (for you came out of the land of Egypt in haste) that you may remember the day when you came out of the land of Egypt all the days of your life.
4 No yeast shall be seen with you in all your borders seven days; neither shall any of the meat, which you sacrifice the first day at evening, remain all night until the morning.
5 You may not sacrifice the Passover within any of your gates which Yahweh your God gives you;
6 but at the place which Yahweh your God shall choose to cause his name to dwell in, there you shall sacrifice the Passover at evening, at the going down of the sun, at the season that you came out of Egypt.
7 You shall roast and eat it in the place which Yahweh your God chooses. In the morning you shall return to your tents.
8 Six days you shall eat unleavened bread. On the seventh day shall be a solemn assembly to Yahweh your God. You shall do no work.
9 You shall count for yourselves seven weeks. From the time you begin to put the sickle to the standing grain you shall begin to count seven weeks.

10 You shall keep the feast of weeks to
Yahweh your God with a tribute of a free
will offering of your hand, which you
shall give according to how Yahweh your
God blesses you.
11 You shall rejoice before Yahweh your
God: you, your son, your daughter, your
male servant, your female servant, the
Levite who is within your gates, the
foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow
who are among you, in the place which
Yahweh your God shall choose to cause
his name to dwell there.
12 You shall remember that you were a
slave in Egypt. You shall observe and do
these statutes.
13 You shall keep the feast of booths
seven days, after you have gathered in
from your threshing floor and from your
wine press.
14 You shall rejoice in your feast, you,
your son, your daughter, your male
servant, your female servant, the Levite,
the foreigner, the fatherless, and the
widow who are within your gates.
15 You shall keep a feast to Yahweh your
God seven days in the place which
Yahweh chooses, because Yahweh your
God will bless you in all your increase and
in all the work of your hands, and you
shall be altogether joyful.
16 Three times in a year all of your
males shall appear before Yahweh your
God in the place which he chooses: in the
feast of unleavened bread, in the feast of
weeks, and in the feast of booths. They
shall not appear before Yahweh empty.
17 Every man shall give as he is able,
according to Yahweh your God's blessing
which he has given you.
18 You shall make judges and officers in
all your gates, which Yahweh your God
gives you, according to your tribes; and
they shall judge the people with righteous
judgment.
19 You shall not pervert justice. You shall
not show partiality. You shall not take a
bribe, for a bribe blinds the eyes of the
wise and perverts the words of the
righteous.
20 You shall follow that which is
altogether just, that you may live and
inherit the land which Yahweh your God
gives you.
21 You shall not plant for yourselves an
Asherah of any kind of tree beside
Yahweh your God's altar, which you shall
make for yourselves.
22 Neither shall you set yourself up a
sacred stone which Yahweh your God
hates.

17

1 You shall not sacrifice to Yahweh your
God an ox or a sheep in which is a defect
or anything evil; for that is an
abomination to Yahweh your God.
2 If there is found among you, within
any of your gates which Yahweh your God
gives you, a man or woman who does that
which is evil in Yahweh your God's sight
in transgressing his covenant,
3 and has gone and served other gods
and worshiped them, or the sun, or the
moon, or any of the stars of the sky, which
I have not commanded,
4 and you are told, and you have heard
of it, then you shall inquire diligently.
Behold, if it is true, and the thing certain,
that such abomination is done in Israel,
5 then you shall bring out that man or
that woman who has done this evil thing
to your gates, even that same man or
woman; and you shall stone them to death
with stones.
6 At the mouth of two witnesses, or
three witnesses, he who is to die shall be
put to death. At the mouth of one witness
he shall not be put to death.
7 The hands of the witnesses shall be
first on him to put him to death, and
afterward the hands of all the people. So
you shall remove the evil from among
you.
8 If there arises a matter too hard for
you in judgment, between blood and
blood, between plea and plea, and
between stroke and stroke, being matters
of controversy within your gates, then
you shall arise, and go up to the place
which Yahweh your God chooses.

9 You shall come to the priests who are
Levites and to the judge who shall be in
those days. You shall inquire, and they
shall give you the verdict.
10 You shall do according to the
decisions of the verdict which they shall
give you from that place which Yahweh
chooses. You shall observe to do
according to all that they shall teach you.
11 According to the decisions of the law
which they shall teach you, and according
to the judgment which they shall tell you,
you shall do. You shall not turn away from
the sentence which they announce to you,
to the right hand, nor to the left.
12 The man who does presumptuously
in not listening to the priest who stands to
minister there before Yahweh your God,
or to the judge, even that man shall die.
You shall put away the evil from Israel.
13 All the people shall hear and fear, and
do no more presumptuously.
14 When you have come to the land
which Yahweh your God gives you, and
possess it and dwell in it, and say, "I will
set a king over me, like all the nations that
are around me,"
15 you shall surely set him whom
Yahweh your God chooses as king over
yourselves. You shall set as king over you
one from among your brothers. You may
not put a foreigner over you, who is not
your brother.
16 Only he shall not multiply horses to
himself, nor cause the people to return to
Egypt, to the end that he may multiply
horses; because Yahweh has said to you,
"You shall not go back that way again."
17 He shall not multiply wives to
himself, that his heart not turn away. He
shall not greatly multiply to himself silver
and gold.
18 It shall be, when he sits on the throne
of his kingdom, that he shall write himself
a copy of this law in a book, out of that
which is before the Levitical priests.
19 It shall be with him, and he shall read
from it all the days of his life, that he may
learn to fear Yahweh his God, to keep all
the words of this law and these statutes, to
do them;
20 that his heart not be lifted up above
his brothers, and that he not turn away
from the commandment to the right hand,
or to the left, to the end that he may
prolong his days in his kingdom, he and
his children, in the middle of Israel.

18

1 The priests and the Levites—all the
tribe of Levi—shall have no portion nor
inheritance with Israel. They shall eat the
offerings of Yahweh made by fire and his
portion.
2 They shall have no inheritance among
their brothers. Yahweh is their
inheritance, as he has spoken to them.
3 This shall be the priests' due from the
people, from those who offer a sacrifice,
whether it be ox or sheep, that they shall
give to the priest: the shoulder, the two
cheeks, and the inner parts.
4 You shall give him the first fruits of
your grain, of your new wine, and of your
oil, and the first of the fleece of your
sheep.
5 For Yahweh your God has chosen him
out of all your tribes to stand to minister
in Yahweh's name, him and his sons
forever.
6 If a Levite comes from any of your
gates out of all Israel where he lives, and
comes with all the desire of his soul to the
place which Yahweh shall choose,
7 then he shall minister in the name of
Yahweh his God, as all his brothers the
Levites do, who stand there before
Yahweh.
8 They shall have like portions to eat, in
addition to that which comes from the
sale of his family possessions.
9 When you have come into the land
which Yahweh your God gives you, you
shall not learn to imitate the
abominations of those nations.
10 There shall not be found with you
anyone who makes his son or his
daughter to pass through the fire, one
who uses divination, one who tells
fortunes, or an enchanter, or a sorcerer,
11 or a charmer, or someone who
consults with a familiar spirit, or a
wizard, or a necromancer.

12 For whoever does these things is an abomination to Yahweh. Because of these abominations, Yahweh your God drives them out from before you.
13 You shall be blameless with Yahweh your God.
14 For these nations that you shall dispossess listen to those who practice sorcery and to diviners; but as for you, Yahweh your God has not allowed you so to do.
15 Yahweh your God will raise up to you a prophet from among you, of your brothers, like me. You shall listen to him.
16 This is according to all that you desired of Yahweh your God in Horeb in the day of the assembly, saying, “Let me not hear again Yahweh my God’s voice, neither let me see this great fire any more, that I not die.”
17 Yahweh said to me, “They have well said that which they have spoken.
18 I will raise them up a prophet from among their brothers, like you. I will put my words in his mouth, and he shall speak to them all that I shall command him.
19 It shall happen, that whoever will not listen to my words which he shall speak in my name, I will require it of him.
20 But the prophet who speaks a word presumptuously in my name, which I have not commanded him to speak, or who speaks in the name of other gods, that same prophet shall die.”
21 You may say in your heart, “How shall we know the word which Yahweh has not spoken?”
22 When a prophet speaks in Yahweh’s name, if the thing doesn’t follow, nor happen, that is the thing which Yahweh has not spoken. The prophet has spoken it presumptuously. You shall not be afraid of him.

19

1 When Yahweh your God cuts off the nations whose land Yahweh your God gives you, and you succeed them and dwell in their cities and in their houses,
2 you shall set apart three cities for yourselves in the middle of your land, which Yahweh your God gives you to possess.
3 You shall prepare the way, and divide the borders of your land which Yahweh your God causes you to inherit into three parts, that every man slayer may flee there.
4 This is the case of the man slayer who shall flee there and live: Whoever kills his neighbor unintentionally, and didn’t hate him in time past—
5 as when a man goes into the forest with his neighbor to chop wood and his hand swings the ax to cut down the tree, and the head slips from the handle and hits his neighbor so that he dies—he shall flee to one of these cities and live.
6 Otherwise, the avenger of blood might pursue the man slayer while hot anger is in his heart and overtake him, because the way is long, and strike him mortally, even though he was not worthy of death, because he didn’t hate him in time past.
7 Therefore I command you to set apart three cities for yourselves.
8 If Yahweh your God enlarges your border, as he has sworn to your fathers, and gives you all the land which he promised to give to your fathers;
9 and if you keep all this commandment to do it, which I command you today, to love Yahweh your God, and to walk ever in his ways, then you shall add three cities more for yourselves, in addition to these three.
10 This is so that innocent blood will not be shed in the middle of your land which Yahweh your God gives you for an inheritance, leaving blood guilt on you.
11 But if any man hates his neighbor, lies in wait for him, rises up against him, strikes him mortally so that he dies, and he flees into one of these cities;
12 then the elders of his city shall send and bring him there, and deliver him into the hand of the avenger of blood, that he may die.
13 Your eye shall not pity him, but you shall purge the innocent blood from Israel that it may go well with you.
14 You shall not remove your neighbor’s

landmark, which they of old time have set, in your inheritance which you shall inherit, in the land that Yahweh your God gives you to possess.

15 One witness shall not rise up against a man for any iniquity, or for any sin that he sins. At the mouth of two witnesses, or at the mouth of three witnesses, shall a matter be established.

16 If an unrighteous witness rises up against any man to testify against him of wrongdoing,

17 then both the men, between whom the controversy is, shall stand before Yahweh, before the priests and the judges who shall be in those days;

18 and the judges shall make diligent inquisition; and behold, if the witness is a false witness, and has testified falsely against his brother,

19 then you shall do to him as he had thought to do to his brother. So you shall remove the evil from among you.

20 Those who remain shall hear, and fear, and will never again commit any such evil among you.

21 Your eyes shall not pity: life for life, eye for eye, tooth for tooth, hand for hand, foot for foot.

20

1 When you go out to battle against your enemies, and see horses, chariots, and a people more numerous than you, you shall not be afraid of them; for Yahweh your God, who brought you up out of the land of Egypt, is with you.

2 It shall be, when you draw near to the battle, that the priest shall approach and speak to the people,

3 and shall tell them, “Hear, Israel, you draw near today to battle against your enemies. Don’t let your heart faint! Don’t be afraid, nor tremble, neither be scared of them;

4 for Yahweh your God is he who goes with you, to fight for you against your enemies, to save you.”

5 The officers shall speak to the people, saying, “What man is there who has built a new house, and has not dedicated it? Let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man dedicate it.

6 What man is there who has planted a vineyard, and has not used its fruit? Let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man use its fruit.

7 What man is there who has pledged to be married to a wife, and has not taken her? Let him go and return to his house, lest he die in the battle, and another man take her.”

8 The officers shall speak further to the people, and they shall say, “What man is there who is fearful and faint-hearted? Let him go and return to his house, lest his brother’s heart melt as his heart.”

9 It shall be, when the officers have finished speaking to the people, that they shall appoint captains of armies at the head of the people.

10 When you draw near to a city to fight against it, then proclaim peace to it.

11 It shall be, if it gives you answer of peace and opens to you, then it shall be that all the people who are found therein shall become forced laborers to you, and shall serve you.

12 If it will make no peace with you, but will make war against you, then you shall besiege it.

13 When Yahweh your God delivers it into your hand, you shall strike every male of it with the edge of the sword;

14 but the women, the little ones, the livestock, and all that is in the city, even all its plunder, you shall take for plunder for yourself. You may use the plunder of your enemies, which Yahweh your God has given you.

15 Thus you shall do to all the cities which are very far off from you, which are not of the cities of these nations.

16 But of the cities of these peoples that Yahweh your God gives you for an inheritance, you shall save alive nothing that breathes;

17 but you shall utterly destroy them: the Hittite, the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, as Yahweh your God has commanded you;

18 that they not teach you to follow all
their abominations, which they have
done for their gods; so would you sin
against Yahweh your God.
19 When you shall besiege a city a long
time, in making war against it to take it,
you shall not destroy its trees by wielding
an ax against them; for you may eat of
them. You shall not cut them down, for is
the tree of the field man, that it should be
besieged by you?
20 Only the trees that you know are not
trees for food, you shall destroy and cut
them down. You shall build bulwarks
against the city that makes war with you,
until it falls.

21

1 If someone is found slain in the land
which Yahweh your God gives you to
possess, lying in the field, and it isn't
known who has struck him,
2 then your elders and your judges shall
come out, and they shall measure to the
cities which are around him who is slain.
3 It shall be that the elders of the city
which is nearest to the slain man shall
take a heifer of the herd, which hasn't
been worked with and which has not
drawn in the yoke.
4 The elders of that city shall bring the
heifer down to a valley with running
water, which is neither plowed nor sown,
and shall break the heifer's neck there in
the valley.
5 The priests the sons of Levi shall come
near, for them Yahweh your God has
chosen to minister to him, and to bless in
Yahweh's name; and according to their
word shall every controversy and every
assault be decided.
6 All the elders of that city which is
nearest to the slain man shall wash their
hands over the heifer whose neck was
broken in the valley.
7 They shall answer and say, "Our hands
have not shed this blood, neither have our
eyes seen it.
8 Forgive, Yahweh, your people Israel,
whom you have redeemed, and don't
allow innocent blood among your people
Israel." The blood shall be forgiven them.
9 So you shall put away the innocent
blood from among you, when you shall do
that which is right in Yahweh's eyes.
10 When you go out to battle against
your enemies, and Yahweh your God
delivers them into your hands and you
carry them away captive,
11 and see among the captives a
beautiful woman, and you are attracted to
her, and desire to take her as your wife,
12 then you shall bring her home to your
house. She shall shave her head and trim
her nails.
13 She shall take off the clothing of her
captivity, and shall remain in your house,
and bewail her father and her mother a
full month. After that you shall go in to
her and be her husband, and she shall be
your wife.
14 It shall be, if you have no delight in
her, then you shall let her go where she
desires; but you shall not sell her at all for
money. You shall not deal with her as a
slave, because you have humbled her.
15 If a man has two wives, the one
beloved and the other hated, and they
have borne him children, both the
beloved and the hated, and if the firstborn
son is hers who was hated,
16 then it shall be, in the day that he
causes his sons to inherit that which he
has, that he may not give the son of the
beloved the rights of the firstborn before
the son of the hated, who is the firstborn;
17 but he shall acknowledge the
firstborn, the son of the hated, by giving
him a double portion of all that he has; for
he is the beginning of his strength. The
right of the firstborn is his.
18 If a man has a stubborn and
rebellious son who will not obey the voice
of his father or the voice of his mother,
and though they chasten him, will not
listen to them,
19 then his father and his mother shall
take hold of him and bring him out to the
elders of his city and to the gate of his
place.
20 They shall tell the elders of his city,
"This our son is stubborn and rebellious.
He will not obey our voice. He is a glutton
and a drunkard."

21 All the men of his city shall stone him
to death with stones. So you shall remove
the evil from among you. All Israel shall
hear, and fear.
22 If a man has committed a sin worthy
of death, and he is put to death, and you
hang him on a tree,
23 his body shall not remain all night on
the tree, but you shall surely bury him the
same day; for he who is hanged is
accursed of God. Don't defile your land
which Yahweh your God gives you for an
inheritance.

22

1 You shall not see your brother's ox or
his sheep go astray and hide yourself
from them. You shall surely bring them
again to your brother.
2 If your brother isn't near to you, or if
you don't know him, then you shall bring
it home to your house, and it shall be with
you until your brother comes looking for
it, and you shall restore it to him.
3 So you shall do with his donkey. So
you shall do with his garment. So you
shall do with every lost thing of your
brother's, which he has lost and you have
found. You may not hide yourself.
4 You shall not see your brother's
donkey or his ox fallen down by the way,
and hide yourself from them. You shall
surely help him to lift them up again.
5 A woman shall not wear men's
clothing, neither shall a man put on
women's clothing; for whoever does these
things is an abomination to Yahweh your
God.
6 If you come across a bird's nest on the
way, in any tree or on the ground, with
young ones or eggs, and the hen sitting on
the young, or on the eggs, you shall not
take the hen with the young.
7 You shall surely let the hen go, but the
young you may take for yourself, that it
may be well with you, and that you may
prolong your days.
8 When you build a new house, then you
shall make a railing around your roof, so
that you don't bring blood on your house
if anyone falls from there.
9 You shall not sow your vineyard with
two kinds of seed, lest all the fruit be
defiled, the seed which you have sown,
and the increase of the vineyard.
10 You shall not plow with an ox and a
donkey together.
11 You shall not wear clothes of wool
and linen woven together.
12 You shall make yourselves fringes† on
the four corners of your cloak with which
you cover yourself.
13 If any man takes a wife, and goes in to
her, hates her,
14 accuses her of shameful things, gives
her a bad name, and says, "I took this
woman, and when I came near to her, I
didn't find in her the tokens of virginity;"
15 then the young lady's father and
mother shall take and bring the tokens of
the young lady's virginity to the elders of
the city in the gate.
16 The young lady's father shall tell the
elders, "I gave my daughter to this man as
his wife, and he hates her.
17 Behold, he has accused her of
shameful things, saying, 'I didn't find in
your daughter the tokens of virginity;'
and yet these are the tokens of my
daughter's virginity." They shall spread
the cloth before the elders of the city.
18 The elders of that city shall take the
man and chastise him.
19 They shall fine him one hundred
shekels of silver,‡ and give them to the
father of the young lady, because he has
given a bad name to a virgin of Israel. She
shall be his wife. He may not put her away
all his days.
20 But if this thing is true, that the tokens
of virginity were not found in the young
lady,
21 then they shall bring out the young
lady to the door of her father's house, and
the men of her city shall stone her to
death with stones, because she has done
folly in Israel, to play the prostitute in her

† **22:12** or, tassels ‡ **22:19** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 100 shekels is about a kilogram or 2.2 pounds.

father's house. So you shall remove the evil from among you.

22 If a man is found lying with a woman married to a husband, then they shall both die, the man who lay with the woman and the woman. So you shall remove the evil from Israel.
23 If there is a young lady who is a virgin pledged to be married to a husband, and a man finds her in the city, and lies with her,
24 then you shall bring them both out to the gate of that city, and you shall stone them to death with stones; the lady, because she didn't cry, being in the city; and the man, because he has humbled his neighbor's wife. So you shall remove the evil from among you.
25 But if the man finds the lady who is pledged to be married in the field, and the man forces her and lies with her, then only the man who lay with her shall die;
26 but to the lady you shall do nothing. There is in the lady no sin worthy of death; for as when a man rises against his neighbor and kills him, even so is this matter;
27 for he found her in the field, the pledged to be married lady cried, and there was no one to save her.
28 If a man finds a lady who is a virgin, who is not pledged to be married, grabs her and lies with her, and they are found,
29 then the man who lay with her shall give to the lady's father fifty shekels§ of silver. She shall be his wife, because he has humbled her. He may not put her away all his days.
30 A man shall not take his father's wife, and shall not uncover his father's skirt.

23

1 He who is emasculated by crushing or cutting shall not enter into Yahweh's assembly.
2 A person born of a forbidden union shall not enter into Yahweh's assembly; even to the tenth generation shall no one of his enter into Yahweh's assembly.
3 An Ammonite or a Moabite shall not enter into Yahweh's assembly; even to the tenth generation shall no one belonging to them enter into Yahweh's assembly forever,
4 because they didn't meet you with bread and with water on the way when you came out of Egypt, and because they hired against you Balaam the son of Beor from Pethor of Mesopotamia, to curse you.
5 Nevertheless Yahweh your God wouldn't listen to Balaam, but Yahweh your God turned the curse into a blessing to you, because Yahweh your God loved you.
6 You shall not seek their peace nor their prosperity all your days forever.
7 You shall not abhor an Edomite, for he is your brother. You shall not abhor an Egyptian, because you lived as a foreigner in his land.
8 The children of the third generation who are born to them may enter into Yahweh's assembly.
9 When you go out and camp against your enemies, then you shall keep yourselves from every evil thing.
10 If there is among you any man who is not clean by reason of that which happens to him by night, then shall he go outside of the camp. He shall not come within the camp;
11 but it shall be, when evening comes, he shall bathe himself in water. When the sun is down, he shall come within the camp.
12 You shall have a place also outside of the camp where you go relieve yourself.
13 You shall have a trowel among your weapons. It shall be, when you relieve yourself, you shall dig with it, and shall turn back and cover your excrement;
14 for Yahweh your God walks in the middle of your camp, to deliver you, and to give up your enemies before you. Therefore your camp shall be holy, that he may not see an unclean thing in you, and turn away from you.
15 You shall not deliver to his master a

§ **22:29** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

servant who has escaped from his master to you.
16 He shall dwell with you, among you, in the place which he shall choose within one of your gates, where it pleases him best. You shall not oppress him.
17 There shall be no prostitute of the daughters of Israel, neither shall there be a sodomite of the sons of Israel.
18 You shall not bring the hire of a prostitute, or the wages of a male prostitute,† into the house of Yahweh your God for any vow; for both of these are an abomination to Yahweh your God.
19 You shall not lend on interest to your brother: interest of money, interest of food, interest of anything that is lent on interest.
20 You may charge a foreigner interest; but you shall not charge your brother interest, that Yahweh your God may bless you in all that you put your hand to, in the land where you go in to possess it.
21 When you vow a vow to Yahweh your God, you shall not be slack to pay it, for Yahweh your God will surely require it of you; and it would be sin in you.
22 But if you refrain from making a vow, it shall be no sin in you.
23 You shall observe and do that which has gone out of your lips. Whatever you have vowed to Yahweh your God as a free will offering, which you have promised with your mouth, you must do.
24 When you come into your neighbor's vineyard, then you may eat your fill of grapes at your own pleasure; but you shall not put any in your container.
25 When you come into your neighbor's standing grain, then you may pluck the ears with your hand; but you shall not use a sickle on your neighbor's standing grain.

24

1 When a man takes a wife and marries her, then it shall be, if she finds no favor in his eyes because he has found some unseemly thing in her, that he shall write her a certificate of divorce, put it in her hand, and send her out of his house.
2 When she has departed out of his house, she may go and be another man's wife.
3 If the latter husband hates her, and writes her a certificate of divorce, puts it in her hand, and sends her out of his house; or if the latter husband dies, who took her to be his wife;
4 her former husband, who sent her away, may not take her again to be his wife after she is defiled; for that would be an abomination to Yahweh. You shall not cause the land to sin, which Yahweh your God gives you for an inheritance.
5 When a man takes a new wife, he shall not go out in the army, neither shall he be assigned any business. He shall be free at home one year, and shall cheer his wife whom he has taken.
6 No man shall take the mill or the upper millstone as a pledge, for he takes a life in pledge.
7 If a man is found stealing any of his brothers of the children of Israel, and he deals with him as a slave, or sells him, then that thief shall die. So you shall remove the evil from among you.
8 Be careful in the plague of leprosy, that you observe diligently and do according to all that the Levitical priests teach you. As I commanded them, so you shall observe to do.
9 Remember what Yahweh your God did to Miriam, by the way as you came out of Egypt.
10 When you lend your neighbor any kind of loan, you shall not go into his house to get his pledge.
11 You shall stand outside, and the man to whom you lend shall bring the pledge outside to you.
12 If he is a poor man, you shall not sleep with his pledge.
13 You shall surely restore to him the pledge when the sun goes down, that he may sleep in his garment and bless you. It shall be righteousness to you before Yahweh your God.
14 You shall not oppress a hired servant who is poor and needy, whether he is one

† **23:18** literally, dog

of your brothers or one of the foreigners who are in your land within your gates.
15 In his day you shall give him his wages, neither shall the sun go down on it, for he is poor and sets his heart on it, lest he cry against you to Yahweh, and it be sin to you.
16 The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, neither shall the children be put to death for the fathers. Every man shall be put to death for his own sin.
17 You shall not deprive the foreigner or the fatherless of justice, nor take a widow's clothing in pledge;
18 but you shall remember that you were a slave in Egypt, and Yahweh your God redeemed you there. Therefore I command you to do this thing.
19 When you reap your harvest in your field, and have forgotten a sheaf in the field, you shall not go again to get it. It shall be for the foreigner, for the fatherless, and for the widow, that Yahweh your God may bless you in all the work of your hands.
20 When you beat your olive tree, you shall not go over the boughs again. It shall be for the foreigner, for the fatherless, and for the widow.
21 When you harvest your vineyard, you shall not glean it after yourselves. It shall be for the foreigner, for the fatherless, and for the widow.
22 You shall remember that you were a slave in the land of Egypt. Therefore I command you to do this thing.

25

1 If there is a controversy between men, and they come to judgment and the judges judge them, then they shall justify the righteous and condemn the wicked.
2 It shall be, if the wicked man is worthy to be beaten, that the judge shall cause him to lie down and to be beaten before his face, according to his wickedness, by number.
3 He may sentence him to no more than forty stripes. He shall not give more, lest if he should give more and beat him more than that many stripes, then your brother will be degraded in your sight.
4 You shall not muzzle the ox when he treads out the grain.
5 If brothers dwell together, and one of them dies and has no son, the wife of the dead shall not be married outside to a stranger. Her husband's brother shall go in to her, and take her as his wife, and perform the duty of a husband's brother to her.
6 It shall be that the firstborn whom she bears shall succeed in the name of his brother who is dead, that his name not be blotted out of Israel.
7 If the man doesn't want to take his brother's wife, then his brother's wife shall go up to the gate to the elders, and say, "My husband's brother refuses to raise up to his brother a name in Israel. He will not perform the duty of a husband's brother to me."
8 Then the elders of his city shall call him, and speak to him. If he stands and says, "I don't want to take her,"
9 then his brother's wife shall come to him in the presence of the elders, and loose his sandal from off his foot, and spit in his face. She shall answer and say, "So shall it be done to the man who does not build up his brother's house."
10 His name shall be called in Israel, "The house of him who had his sandal removed."
11 When men strive against each other, and the wife of one draws near to deliver her husband out of the hand of him who strikes him, and puts out her hand, and grabs him by his private parts,
12 then you shall cut off her hand. Your eye shall have no pity.
13 You shall not have in your bag diverse weights, one heavy and one light.
14 You shall not have in your house diverse measures, one large and one small.
15 You shall have a perfect and just weight. You shall have a perfect and just measure, that your days may be long in the land which Yahweh your God gives you.

16 For all who do such things, all who do unrighteously, are an abomination to Yahweh your God.

17 Remember what Amalek did to you by the way as you came out of Egypt,
18 how he met you by the way, and struck the rearmost of you, all who were feeble behind you, when you were faint and weary; and he didn't fear God.
19 Therefore it shall be, when Yahweh your God has given you rest from all your enemies all around, in the land which Yahweh your God gives you for an inheritance to possess it, that you shall blot out the memory of Amalek from under the sky. You shall not forget.

26

1 It shall be, when you have come in to the land which Yahweh your God gives you for an inheritance, possess it, and dwell in it,
2 that you shall take some of the first of all the fruit of the ground, which you shall bring in from your land that Yahweh your God gives you. You shall put it in a basket, and shall go to the place which Yahweh your God shall choose to cause his name to dwell there.
3 You shall come to the priest who shall be in those days, and tell him, "I profess today to Yahweh your God, that I have come to the land which Yahweh swore to our fathers to give us."
4 The priest shall take the basket out of your hand, and set it down before Yahweh your God's altar.
5 You shall answer and say before Yahweh your God, "My father† was a Syrian ready to perish. He went down into Egypt, and lived there, few in number. There he became a great, mighty, and populous nation.
6 The Egyptians mistreated us, afflicted us, and imposed hard labor on us.
7 Then we cried to Yahweh, the God of our fathers. Yahweh heard our voice, and saw our affliction, our toil, and our oppression.
8 Yahweh brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand, with an outstretched arm, with great terror, with signs, and with wonders;
9 and he has brought us into this place, and has given us this land, a land flowing with milk and honey.
10 Now, behold, I have brought the first of the fruit of the ground, which you, Yahweh, have given me." You shall set it down before Yahweh your God, and worship before Yahweh your God.
11 You shall rejoice in all the good which Yahweh your God has given to you, and to your house, you, and the Levite, and the foreigner who is among you.

12 When you have finished tithing all the tithe of your increase in the third year, which is the year of tithing, then you shall give it to the Levite, to the foreigner, to the fatherless, and to the widow, that they may eat within your gates and be filled.
13 You shall say before Yahweh your God, "I have put away the holy things out of my house, and also have given them to the Levite, to the foreigner, to the fatherless, and to the widow, according to all your commandment which you have commanded me. I have not transgressed any of your commandments, neither have I forgotten them.
14 I have not eaten of it in my mourning, neither have I removed any of it while I was unclean, nor given of it for the dead. I have listened to Yahweh my God's voice. I have done according to all that you have commanded me.
15 Look down from your holy habitation, from heaven, and bless your people Israel, and the ground which you have given us, as you swore to our fathers, a land flowing with milk and honey."

16 Today Yahweh your God commands you to do these statutes and ordinances. You shall therefore keep and do them with all your heart and with all your soul.
17 You have declared today that Yahweh is your God, and that you would walk in his ways, keep his statutes, his

† **26:5** or, forefather

commandments, and his ordinances, and listen to his voice.
18 Yahweh has declared today that you are a people for his own possession, as he has promised you, and that you should keep all his commandments.
19 He will make you high above all nations that he has made, in praise, in name, and in honor, and that you may be a holy people to Yahweh your God, as he has spoken.

27

1 Moses and the elders of Israel commanded the people, saying, "Keep all the commandment which I command you today.
2 It shall be on the day when you shall pass over the Jordan to the land which Yahweh your God gives you, that you shall set yourself up great stones, and coat them with plaster.
3 You shall write on them all the words of this law, when you have passed over, that you may go in to the land which Yahweh your God gives you, a land flowing with milk and honey, as Yahweh, the God of your fathers, has promised you.
4 It shall be, when you have crossed over the Jordan, that you shall set up these stones, which I command you today, on Mount Ebal, and you shall coat them with plaster.
5 There you shall build an altar to Yahweh your God, an altar of stones. You shall not use any iron tool on them.
6 You shall build Yahweh your God's altar of uncut stones. You shall offer burnt offerings on it to Yahweh your God.
7 You shall sacrifice peace offerings, and shall eat there. You shall rejoice before Yahweh your God.
8 You shall write on the stones all the words of this law very plainly."
9 Moses and the Levitical priests spoke to all Israel, saying, "Be silent and listen, Israel! Today you have become the people of Yahweh your God.
10 You shall therefore obey Yahweh your God's voice, and do his commandments and his statutes, which I command you today."
11 Moses commanded the people the same day, saying,
12 "These shall stand on Mount Gerizim to bless the people, when you have crossed over the Jordan: Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Joseph, and Benjamin.
13 These shall stand on Mount Ebal for the curse: Reuben, Gad, Asher, Zebulun, Dan, and Naphtali.
14 With a loud voice, the Levites shall say to all the men of Israel,
15 'Cursed is the man who makes an engraved or molten image, an abomination to Yahweh, the work of the hands of the craftsman, and sets it up in secret.'
All the people shall answer and say, 'Amen.'
16 'Cursed is he who dishonors his father or his mother.'
All the people shall say, 'Amen.'
17 'Cursed is he who removes his neighbor's landmark.'
All the people shall say, 'Amen.'
18 'Cursed is he who leads the blind astray on the road.'
All the people shall say, 'Amen.'
19 'Cursed is he who withholds justice from the foreigner, fatherless, and widow.'
All the people shall say, 'Amen.'
20 'Cursed is he who lies with† his father's wife, because he dishonors his father's bed.'
All the people shall say, 'Amen.'
21 'Cursed is he who lies with any kind of animal.'
All the people shall say, 'Amen.'
22 'Cursed is he who lies with his sister, his father's daughter or his mother's daughter.'
All the people shall say, 'Amen.'
23 'Cursed is he who lies with his mother-in-law.'
All the people shall say, 'Amen.'
24 'Cursed is he who secretly kills his neighbor.'
All the people shall say, 'Amen.'
25 'Cursed is he who takes a bribe to kill an innocent person.'

† **27:20** i.e., has sexual relations with

All the people shall say, ‘Amen.’
26 ‘Cursed is he who doesn’t uphold the words of this law by doing them.’
All the people shall say, ‘Amen.’ ”

28

1 It shall happen, if you shall listen diligently to Yahweh your God’s voice, to observe to do all his commandments which I command you today, that Yahweh your God will set you high above all the nations of the earth.
2 All these blessings will come upon you, and overtake you, if you listen to Yahweh your God’s voice.
3 You shall be blessed in the city, and you shall be blessed in the field.
4 You shall be blessed in the fruit of your body, the fruit of your ground, the fruit of your animals, the increase of your livestock, and the young of your flock.
5 Your basket and your kneading trough shall be blessed.
6 You shall be blessed when you come in, and you shall be blessed when you go out.
7 Yahweh will cause your enemies who rise up against you to be struck before you. They will come out against you one way, and will flee before you seven ways.
8 Yahweh will command the blessing on you in your barns, and in all that you put your hand to. He will bless you in the land which Yahweh your God gives you.
9 Yahweh will establish you for a holy people to himself, as he has sworn to you, if you shall keep the commandments of Yahweh your God, and walk in his ways.
10 All the peoples of the earth shall see that you are called by Yahweh’s name, and they will be afraid of you.
11 Yahweh will grant you abundant prosperity in the fruit of your body, in the fruit of your livestock, and in the fruit of your ground, in the land which Yahweh swore to your fathers to give you.
12 Yahweh will open to you his good treasure in the sky, to give the rain of your land in its season, and to bless all the work of your hand. You will lend to many nations, and you will not borrow.
13 Yahweh will make you the head, and not the tail. You will be above only, and you will not be beneath, if you listen to the commandments of Yahweh your God which I command you today, to observe and to do,
14 and shall not turn away from any of the words which I command you today, to the right hand or to the left, to go after other gods to serve them.
15 But it shall come to pass, if you will not listen to Yahweh your God’s voice, to observe to do all his commandments and his statutes which I command you today, that all these curses will come on you and overtake you.
16 You will be cursed in the city, and you will be cursed in the field.
17 Your basket and your kneading trough will be cursed.
18 The fruit of your body, the fruit of your ground, the increase of your livestock, and the young of your flock will be cursed.
19 You will be cursed when you come in, and you will be cursed when you go out.
20 Yahweh will send on you cursing, confusion, and rebuke in all that you put your hand to do, until you are destroyed and until you perish quickly, because of the evil of your doings, by which you have forsaken me.
21 Yahweh will make the pestilence cling to you, until he has consumed you from off the land where you go in to possess it.
22 Yahweh will strike you with consumption, with fever, with inflammation, with fiery heat, with the sword, with blight, and with mildew. They will pursue you until you perish.
23 Your sky that is over your head will be bronze, and the earth that is under you will be iron.
24 Yahweh will make the rain of your land powder and dust. It will come down on you from the sky, until you are destroyed.
25 Yahweh will cause you to be struck before your enemies. You will go out one way against them, and will flee seven ways before them. You will be tossed back

and forth among all the kingdoms of the earth.
26 Your dead bodies will be food to all birds of the sky, and to the animals of the earth; and there will be no one to frighten them away.
27 Yahweh will strike you with the boils of Egypt, with the tumors, with the scurvy, and with the itch, of which you can not be healed.
28 Yahweh will strike you with madness, with blindness, and with astonishment of heart.
29 You will grope at noonday, as the blind gropes in darkness, and you shall not prosper in your ways. You will only be oppressed and robbed always, and there will be no one to save you.
30 You will betroth a wife, and another man shall lie with her. You will build a house, and you won't dwell in it. You will plant a vineyard, and not use its fruit.
31 Your ox will be slain before your eyes, and you will not eat any of it. Your donkey will be violently taken away from before your face, and will not be restored to you. Your sheep will be given to your enemies, and you will have no one to save you.
32 Your sons and your daughters will be given to another people. Your eyes will look and fail with longing for them all day long. There will be no power in your hand.
33 A nation which you don't know will eat the fruit of your ground and all of your work. You will only be oppressed and crushed always,
34 so that the sights that you see with your eyes will drive you mad.
35 Yahweh will strike you in the knees and in the legs with a sore boil, of which you cannot be healed, from the sole of your foot to the crown of your head.
36 Yahweh will bring you, and your king whom you will set over yourselves, to a nation that you have not known, you nor your fathers. There you will serve other gods of wood and stone.
37 You will become an astonishment, a proverb, and a byword among all the peoples where Yahweh will lead you away.
38 You will carry much seed out into the field, and will gather little in, for the locust will consume it.
39 You will plant vineyards and dress them, but you will neither drink of the wine, nor harvest, because worms will eat them.
40 You will have olive trees throughout all your borders, but you won't anoint yourself with the oil, for your olives will drop off.
41 You will father sons and daughters, but they will not be yours, for they will go into captivity.
42 Locusts will consume all of your trees and the fruit of your ground.
43 The foreigner who is among you will mount up above you higher and higher, and you will come down lower and lower.
44 He will lend to you, and you won't lend to him. He will be the head, and you will be the tail.
45 All these curses will come on you, and will pursue you and overtake you, until you are destroyed, because you didn't listen to Yahweh your God's voice, to keep his commandments and his statutes which he commanded you.
46 They will be for a sign and for a wonder to you and to your offspring forever.
47 Because you didn't serve Yahweh your God with joyfulness and with gladness of heart, by reason of the abundance of all things;
48 therefore you will serve your enemies whom Yahweh sends against you, in hunger, in thirst, in nakedness, and in lack of all things. He will put an iron yoke on your neck until he has destroyed you.
49 Yahweh will bring a nation against you from far away, from the end of the earth, as the eagle flies: a nation whose language you will not understand,
50 a nation of fierce facial expressions, that doesn't respect the elderly, nor show favor to the young.
51 They will eat the fruit of your livestock and the fruit of your ground, until you are destroyed. They also won't leave you grain, new wine, oil, the

increase of your livestock, or the young of your flock, until they have caused you to perish.
52 They will besiege you in all your gates until your high and fortified walls in which you trusted come down throughout all your land. They will besiege you in all your gates throughout all your land which Yahweh your God has given you.
53 You will eat the fruit of your own body, the flesh of your sons and of your daughters, whom Yahweh your God has given you, in the siege and in the distress with which your enemies will distress you.
54 The man who is tender among you, and very delicate, his eye will be evil toward his brother, toward the wife whom he loves, and toward the remnant of his children whom he has remaining,
55 so that he will not give to any of them of the flesh of his children whom he will eat, because he has nothing left to him, in the siege and in the distress with which your enemy will distress you in all your gates.
56 The tender and delicate woman among you, who would not venture to set the sole of her foot on the ground for delicateness and tenderness, her eye will be evil toward the husband that she loves, toward her son, toward her daughter,
57 toward her young one who comes out from between her feet, and toward her children whom she bears; for she will eat them secretly for lack of all things in the siege and in the distress with which your enemy will distress you in your gates.
58 If you will not observe to do all the words of this law that are written in this book, that you may fear this glorious and fearful name, YAHWEH your God,
59 then Yahweh will make your plagues and the plagues of your offspring fearful, even great plagues, and of long duration, and severe sicknesses, and of long duration.
60 He will bring on you again all the diseases of Egypt, which you were afraid of; and they will cling to you.
61 Also every sickness and every plague which is not written in the book of this law, Yahweh will bring them on you until you are destroyed.
62 You will be left few in number, even though you were as the stars of the sky for multitude, because you didn't listen to Yahweh your God's voice.
63 It will happen that as Yahweh rejoiced over you to do you good, and to multiply you, so Yahweh will rejoice over you to cause you to perish and to destroy you. You will be plucked from the land that you are going in to possess.
64 Yahweh will scatter you among all peoples, from one end of the earth to the other end of the earth. There you will serve other gods which you have not known, you nor your fathers, even wood and stone.
65 Among these nations you will find no ease, and there will be no rest for the sole of your foot; but Yahweh will give you there a trembling heart, failing of eyes, and pining of soul.
66 Your life will hang in doubt before you. You will be afraid night and day, and will have no assurance of your life.
67 In the morning you will say, "I wish it were evening!" and at evening you will say, "I wish it were morning!" for the fear of your heart which you will fear, and for the sights which your eyes will see.
68 Yahweh will bring you into Egypt again with ships, by the way of which I told you that you would never see it again. There you will offer yourselves to your enemies for male and female slaves, and nobody will buy you.

29

1 These are the words of the covenant which Yahweh commanded Moses to make with the children of Israel in the land of Moab, in addition to the covenant which he made with them in Horeb.
2 Moses called to all Israel, and said to them:
Your eyes have seen all that Yahweh did in the land of Egypt to Pharaoh, and to all his servants, and to all his land;
3 the great trials which your eyes saw, the signs, and those great wonders.

4 But Yahweh has not given you a heart
to know, eyes to see, and ears to hear, to
this day.
5 I have led you forty years in the
wilderness. Your clothes have not grown
old on you, and your sandals have not
grown old on your feet.
6 You have not eaten bread, neither
have you drunk wine or strong drink, that
you may know that I am Yahweh your
God.
7 When you came to this place, Sihon
the king of Heshbon and Og the king of
Bashan came out against us to battle, and
we struck them.
8 We took their land, and gave it for an
inheritance to the Reubenites, and to the
Gadites, and to the half-tribe of the
Manassites.
9 Therefore keep the words of this
covenant and do them, that you may
prosper in all that you do.
10 All of you stand today in the presence
of Yahweh your God: your heads, your
tribes, your elders, and your officers, even
all the men of Israel,
11 your little ones, your wives, and the
foreigners who are in the middle of your
camps, from the one who cuts your wood
to the one who draws your water,
12 that you may enter into the covenant
of Yahweh your God, and into his oath,
which Yahweh your God makes with you
today,
13 that he may establish you today as his
people, and that he may be your God, as
he spoke to you and as he swore to your
fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to
Jacob.
14 Neither do I make this covenant and
this oath with you only,
15 but with those who stand here with
us today before Yahweh our God, and also
with those who are not here with us today
16 (for you know how we lived in the
land of Egypt, and how we came through
the middle of the nations through which
you passed;
17 and you have seen their
abominations and their idols of wood,
stone, silver, and gold, which were among
them);
18 lest there should be among you man,
woman, family, or tribe whose heart
turns away today from Yahweh our God,
to go to serve the gods of those nations;
lest there should be among you a root that
produces bitter poison;
19 and it happen, when he hears the
words of this curse, that he bless himself
in his heart, saying, “I shall have peace,
though I walk in the stubbornness of my
heart,” to destroy the moist with the dry.
20 Yahweh will not pardon him, but then
Yahweh’s anger and his jealousy will
smoke against that man, and all the curse
that is written in this book will fall on
him, and Yahweh will blot out his name
from under the sky.
21 Yahweh will set him apart for evil out
of all the tribes of Israel, according to all
the curses of the covenant written in this
book of the law.
22 The generation to come—your
children who will rise up after you, and
the foreigner who will come from a far
land—will say, when they see the plagues
of that land, and the sicknesses with
which Yahweh has made it sick,
23 that all of its land is sulfur, salt, and
burning, that it is not sown, doesn’t
produce, nor does any grass grow in it,
like the overthrow of Sodom, Gomorrah,
Admah, and Zeboiim, which Yahweh
overthrew in his anger, and in his wrath.
24 Even all the nations will say, “Why
has Yahweh done this to this land? What
does the heat of this great anger mean?”
25 Then men will say, “Because they
abandoned the covenant of Yahweh, the
God of their fathers, which he made with
them when he brought them out of the
land of Egypt,
26 and went and served other gods and
worshiped them, gods that they didn’t
know and that he had not given to them.
27 Therefore Yahweh’s anger burned
against this land, to bring on it all the
curses that are written in this book.
28 Yahweh rooted them out of their land
in anger, in wrath, and in great
indignation, and thrust them into another
land, as it is today.”

29 The secret things belong to Yahweh
our God; but the things that are revealed
belong to us and to our children forever,
that we may do all the words of this law.

30

1 It shall happen, when all these things
have come on you, the blessing and the
curse, which I have set before you, and
you shall call them to mind among all the
nations where Yahweh your God has
driven you,
2 and return to Yahweh your God and
obey his voice according to all that I
command you today, you and your
children, with all your heart and with all
your soul,
3 that then Yahweh your God will
release you from captivity, have
compassion on you, and will return and
gather you from all the peoples where
Yahweh your God has scattered you.
4 If your outcasts are in the uttermost
parts of the heavens, from there Yahweh
your God will gather you, and from there
he will bring you back.
5 Yahweh your God will bring you into
the land which your fathers possessed,
and you will possess it. He will do you
good, and increase your numbers more
than your fathers.
6 Yahweh your God will circumcise your
heart, and the heart of your offspring, to
love Yahweh your God with all your heart
and with all your soul, that you may live.
7 Yahweh your God will put all these
curses on your enemies and on those who
hate you, who persecuted you.
8 You shall return and obey Yahweh's
voice, and do all his commandments
which I command you today.
9 Yahweh your God will make you
prosperous in all the work of your hand,
in the fruit of your body, in the fruit of
your livestock, and in the fruit of your
ground, for good; for Yahweh will again
rejoice over you for good, as he rejoiced
over your fathers,
10 if you will obey Yahweh your God's
voice, to keep his commandments and his
statutes which are written in this book of
the law, if you turn to Yahweh your God
with all your heart and with all your soul.
11 For this commandment which I
command you today is not too hard for
you or too distant.
12 It is not in heaven, that you should
say, "Who will go up for us to heaven,
bring it to us, and proclaim it to us, that
we may do it?"
13 Neither is it beyond the sea, that you
should say, "Who will go over the sea for
us, bring it to us, and proclaim it to us,
that we may do it?"
14 But the word is very near to you, in
your mouth and in your heart, that you
may do it.
15 Behold, I have set before you today
life and prosperity, and death and evil.
16 For I command you today to love
Yahweh your God, to walk in his ways and
to keep his commandments, his statutes,
and his ordinances, that you may live and
multiply, and that Yahweh your God may
bless you in the land where you go in to
possess it.
17 But if your heart turns away, and you
will not hear, but are drawn away and
worship other gods, and serve them,
18 I declare to you today that you will
surely perish. You will not prolong your
days in the land where you pass over the
Jordan to go in to possess it.
19 I call heaven and earth to witness
against you today that I have set before
you life and death, the blessing and the
curse. Therefore choose life, that you may
live, you and your descendants,
20 to love Yahweh your God, to obey his
voice, and to cling to him; for he is your
life, and the length of your days, that you
may dwell in the land which Yahweh
swore to your fathers, to Abraham, to
Isaac, and to Jacob, to give them.

31

1 Moses went and spoke these words to
all Israel.
2 He said to them, "I am one hundred
twenty years old today. I can no more go

out and come in. Yahweh has said to me, ‘You shall not go over this Jordan.’
3 Yahweh your God himself will go over before you. He will destroy these nations from before you, and you shall dispossess them. Joshua will go over before you, as Yahweh has spoken.
4 Yahweh will do to them as he did to Sihon and to Og, the kings of the Amorites, and to their land, when he destroyed them.
5 Yahweh will deliver them up before you, and you shall do to them according to all the commandment which I have commanded you.
6 Be strong and courageous. Don’t be afraid or scared of them, for Yahweh your God himself is who goes with you. He will not fail you nor forsake you.”

7 Moses called to Joshua, and said to him in the sight of all Israel, “Be strong and courageous, for you shall go with this people into the land which Yahweh has sworn to their fathers to give them; and you shall cause them to inherit it.
8 Yahweh himself is who goes before you. He will be with you. He will not fail you nor forsake you. Don’t be afraid. Don’t be discouraged.”

9 Moses wrote this law and delivered it to the priests the sons of Levi, who bore the ark of Yahweh’s covenant, and to all the elders of Israel.
10 Moses commanded them, saying, “At the end of every seven years, in the set time of the year of release, in the feast of booths,
11 when all Israel has come to appear before Yahweh your God in the place which he will choose, you shall read this law before all Israel in their hearing.
12 Assemble the people, the men and the women and the little ones, and the foreigners who are within your gates, that they may hear, learn, fear Yahweh your God, and observe to do all the words of this law,
13 and that their children, who have not known, may hear and learn to fear Yahweh your God, as long as you live in the land where you go over the Jordan to possess it.”
14 Yahweh said to Moses, “Behold, your days approach that you must die. Call Joshua, and present yourselves in the Tent of Meeting, that I may commission him.”
Moses and Joshua went, and presented themselves in the Tent of Meeting.
15 Yahweh appeared in the Tent in a pillar of cloud, and the pillar of cloud stood over the Tent’s door.
16 Yahweh said to Moses, “Behold, you shall sleep with your fathers. This people will rise up and play the prostitute after the strange gods of the land where they go to be among them, and will forsake me and break my covenant which I have made with them.
17 Then my anger shall be kindled against them in that day, and I will forsake them, and I will hide my face from them, and they shall be devoured, and many evils and troubles shall come on them; so that they will say in that day, ‘Haven’t these evils come on us because our God is not among us?’
18 I will surely hide my face in that day for all the evil which they have done, in that they have turned to other gods.
19 “Now therefore write this song for yourselves, and teach it to the children of Israel. Put it in their mouths, that this song may be a witness for me against the children of Israel.
20 For when I have brought them into the land which I swore to their fathers, flowing with milk and honey, and they have eaten and filled themselves, and grown fat, then they will turn to other gods, and serve them, and despise me, and break my covenant.
21 It will happen, when many evils and troubles have come on them, that this song will testify before them as a witness; for it will not be forgotten out of the mouths of their descendants; for I know their ways and what they are doing today, before I have brought them into the land which I promised them.”
22 So Moses wrote this song the same day, and taught it to the children of Israel.

23 He commissioned Joshua the son of
Nun, and said, “Be strong and courageous;
for you shall bring the children of Israel
into the land which I swore to them. I will
be with you.”
24 When Moses had finished writing the
words of this law in a book, until they
were finished,
25 Moses commanded the Levites, who
bore the ark of Yahweh’s covenant,
saying,
26 “Take this book of the law, and put it
by the side of the ark of Yahweh your
God’s covenant, that it may be there for a
witness against you.
27 For I know your rebellion and your
stiff neck. Behold, while I am yet alive
with you today, you have been rebellious
against Yahweh. How much more after
my death?
28 Assemble to me all the elders of your
tribes and your officers, that I may speak
these words in their ears, and call heaven
and earth to witness against them.
29 For I know that after my death you
will utterly corrupt yourselves, and turn
away from the way which I have
commanded you; and evil will happen to
you in the latter days, because you will do
that which is evil in Yahweh’s sight, to
provoke him to anger through the work of
your hands.”
30 Moses spoke in the ears of all the
assembly of Israel the words of this song,
until they were finished.

32

1 Give ear, you heavens, and I will speak.
Let the earth hear the words of my
mouth.
2 My doctrine will drop as the rain.
My speech will condense as the dew,
as the misty rain on the tender grass,
as the showers on the herb.
3 For I will proclaim Yahweh’s name.
Ascribe greatness to our God!
4 The Rock: his work is perfect,
for all his ways are just.
A God of faithfulness who does no
wrong,
just and right is he.
5 They have dealt corruptly with him.
They are not his children, because of
their defect.
They are a perverse and crooked
generation.
6 Is this the way you repay Yahweh,
foolish and unwise people?
Isn’t he your father who has bought you?
He has made you and established you.
7 Remember the days of old.
Consider the years of many
generations.
Ask your father, and he will show you;
your elders, and they will tell you.
8 When the Most High gave to the nations
their inheritance,
when he separated the children of
men,
he set the bounds of the peoples
according to the number of the
children of Israel.
9 For Yahweh’s portion is his people.
Jacob is the lot of his inheritance.
10 He found him in a desert land,
in the waste howling wilderness.
He surrounded him.
He cared for him.
He kept him as the apple of his eye.
11 As an eagle that stirs up her nest,
that flutters over her young,
he spread abroad his wings,
he took them,
he bore them on his feathers.
12 Yahweh alone led him.
There was no foreign god with him.
13 He made him ride on the high places of
the earth.
He ate the increase of the field.
He caused him to suck honey out of the
rock,
oil out of the flinty rock;
14 butter from the herd, and milk from the
flock,
with fat of lambs,
rams of the breed of Bashan, and
goats,
with the finest of the wheat.
From the blood of the grape, you
drank wine.
15 But Jeshurun grew fat, and kicked.
You have grown fat.
You have grown thick.
You have become sleek.

Then he abandoned God who made him,
and rejected the Rock of his salvation.
16 They moved him to jealousy with
strange gods.
They provoked him to anger with
abominations.
17 They sacrificed to demons, not God,
to gods that they didn't know,
to new gods that came up recently,
which your fathers didn't dread.
18 Of the Rock who became your father,
you are unmindful,
and have forgotten God who gave you
birth.
19 Yahweh saw and abhorred,
because of the provocation of his sons
and his daughters.
20 He said, "I will hide my face from them.
I will see what their end will be;
for they are a very perverse generation,
children in whom is no faithfulness.
21 They have moved me to jealousy with
that which is not God.
They have provoked me to anger with
their vanities.
I will move them to jealousy with those
who are not a people.
I will provoke them to anger with a
foolish nation.
22 For a fire is kindled in my anger,
that burns to the lowest Sheol,†
devours the earth with its increase,
and sets the foundations of the
mountains on fire.

23 "I will heap evils on them.
I will spend my arrows on them.
24 They shall be wasted with hunger,
and devoured with burning heat
and bitter destruction.
I will send the teeth of animals on them,
with the venom of vipers that glide in
the dust.
25 Outside the sword will bereave,
and in the rooms,
terror on both young man and virgin,
the nursing infant with the
gray-haired man.
26 I said that I would scatter them afar.
I would make their memory to cease
from among men;
27 were it not that I feared the provocation
of the enemy,
lest their adversaries should judge
wrongly,
lest they should say, 'Our hand is
exalted;
Yahweh has not done all this.' "

28 For they are a nation void of counsel.
There is no understanding in them.
29 Oh that they were wise, that they
understood this,
that they would consider their latter
end!
30 How could one chase a thousand,
and two put ten thousand to flight,
unless their Rock had sold them,
and Yahweh had delivered them up?
31 For their rock is not as our Rock,
even our enemies themselves
concede.
32 For their vine is of the vine of Sodom,
of the fields of Gomorrah.
Their grapes are poison grapes.
Their clusters are bitter.
33 Their wine is the poison of serpents,
the cruel venom of asps.

34 "Isn't this laid up in store with me,
sealed up among my treasures?
35 Vengeance is mine, and recompense,
at the time when their foot slides,
for the day of their calamity is at hand.
Their doom rushes at them."

36 For Yahweh will judge his people,
and have compassion on his servants,
when he sees that their power is gone,
that there is no one remaining, shut
up or left at large.
37 He will say, "Where are their gods,
the rock in which they took refuge,
38 which ate the fat of their sacrifices,
and drank the wine of their drink
offering?
Let them rise up and help you!
Let them be your protection.

39 "See now that I myself am he.
There is no god with me.
I kill and I make alive.
I wound and I heal.

† **32:22** Sheol is the place of the dead.

There is no one who can deliver out of my hand.
40 For I lift up my hand to heaven and declare,
as I live forever,
41 if I sharpen my glittering sword,
my hand grasps it in judgment;
I will take vengeance on my adversaries,
and will repay those who hate me.
42 I will make my arrows drunk with blood.
My sword shall devour flesh with the blood of the slain and the captives,
from the head of the leaders of the enemy."

43 Rejoice, you nations, with his people,
for he will avenge the blood of his servants.
He will take vengeance on his adversaries,
and will make atonement for his land and for his people.‡

44 Moses came and spoke all the words of this song in the ears of the people, he and Joshua the son of Nun.
45 Moses finished reciting all these words to all Israel.
46 He said to them, "Set your heart to all the words which I testify to you today, which you shall command your children to observe to do, all the words of this law.
47 For it is no vain thing for you, because it is your life, and through this thing you shall prolong your days in the land, where you go over the Jordan to possess it."
48 Yahweh spoke to Moses that same day, saying,
49 "Go up into this mountain of Abarim, to Mount Nebo, which is in the land of Moab, that is across from Jericho; and see the land of Canaan, which I give to the children of Israel for a possession.
50 Die on the mountain where you go up, and be gathered to your people, as Aaron your brother died on Mount Hor, and was gathered to his people;
51 because you trespassed against me among the children of Israel at the waters of Meribah of Kadesh, in the wilderness of Zin; because you didn't uphold my holiness among the children of Israel.
52 For you shall see the land from a distance; but you shall not go there into the land which I give the children of Israel."

33

1 This is the blessing with which Moses the man of God blessed the children of Israel before his death.
2 He said,
"Yahweh came from Sinai,
and rose from Seir to them.
He shone from Mount Paran.
He came from the ten thousands of holy ones.
At his right hand was a fiery law for them.†
3 Yes, he loves the people.
All his saints are in your hand.
They sat down at your feet.
Each receives your words.
4 Moses commanded us a law,
an inheritance for the assembly of Jacob.
5 He was king in Jeshurun,
when the heads of the people were gathered,
all the tribes of Israel together.

6 "Let Reuben live, and not die;
Nor let his men be few."
7 This is for Judah. He said,
"Hear, Yahweh, the voice of Judah.
Bring him in to his people.
With his hands he contended for himself.
You shall be a help against his adversaries."
8 About Levi he said,
"Your Thummim and your Urim are with your godly one,
whom you proved at Massah,
with whom you contended at the waters of Meribah.

‡ **32:43** For this verse, LXX reads: Rejoice, you heavens, with him, and let all the angels of God worship him; rejoice you Gentiles, with his people, and let all the sons of God strengthen themselves in him; for he will avenge the blood of his sons, and he will give vengeance, and recompense justice to his enemies, and will reward them that hate him; and the Lord shall purge the land of his people. † **33:2** another manuscript reads "He came with myriads of holy ones from the south, from his mountain slopes."

9 He said of his father, and of his mother, ‘I
have not seen him.’
He didn’t acknowledge his brothers,
nor did he know his own children;
for they have observed your word,
and keep your covenant.
10 They shall teach Jacob your ordinances,
and Israel your law.
They shall put incense before you,
and whole burnt offering on your
altar.
11 Yahweh, bless his skills.
Accept the work of his hands.
Strike through the hips of those who rise
up against him,
of those who hate him, that they not
rise again.”
12 About Benjamin he said,
“The beloved of Yahweh will dwell in
safety by him.
He covers him all day long.
He dwells between his shoulders.”
13 About Joseph he said,
“His land is blessed by Yahweh,
for the precious things of the
heavens, for the dew,
for the deep that couches beneath,
14 for the precious things of the fruits of
the sun,
for the precious things that the moon
can yield,
15 for the best things of the ancient
mountains,
for the precious things of the
everlasting hills,
16 for the precious things of the earth and
its fullness,
the good will of him who lived in the
bush.‡
Let this come on the head of Joseph,
on the crown of the head of him who
was separated from his brothers.
17 Majesty belongs to the firstborn of his
herd.
His horns are the horns of the wild ox.
With them he will push all the
peoples to the ends of the earth.
They are the ten thousands of Ephraim.
They are the thousands of Manasseh.”
18 About Zebulun he said,
“Rejoice, Zebulun, in your going out;
and Issachar, in your tents.
19 They will call the peoples to the
mountain.
There they will offer sacrifices of
righteousness,
for they will draw out the abundance of
the seas,
the hidden treasures of the sand.”
20 About Gad he said,
“He who enlarges Gad is blessed.
He dwells as a lioness,
and tears the arm and the crown of
the head.
21 He provided the first part for himself,
for the lawgiver’s portion was
reserved for him.
He came with the heads of the people.
He executed the righteousness of
Yahweh,
His ordinances with Israel.”
22 About Dan he said,
“Dan is a lion’s cub
that leaps out of Bashan.”
23 About Naphtali he said,
“Naphtali, satisfied with favor,
full of Yahweh’s blessing,
Possess the west and the south.”
24 About Asher he said,
“Asher is blessed with children.
Let him be acceptable to his brothers.
Let him dip his foot in oil.
25 Your bars will be iron and bronze.
As your days, so your strength will be.

26 “There is no one like God, Jeshurun,
who rides on the heavens for your
help,
in his excellency on the skies.
27 The eternal God is your dwelling place.
Underneath are the everlasting arms.
He thrust out the enemy from before you,
and said, ‘Destroy!’
28 Israel dwells in safety,
the fountain of Jacob alone,
In a land of grain and new wine.
Yes, his heavens drop down dew.
29 You are happy, Israel!
Who is like you, a people saved by
Yahweh,
the shield of your help,
the sword of your excellency?

‡ **33:16** i.e., the burning bush of Exodus 3:3-4.

Your enemies will submit themselves to you.
You will tread on their high places."

34

1 Moses went up from the plains of
Moab to Mount Nebo, to the top of Pisgah,
that is opposite Jericho. Yahweh showed
him all the land of Gilead to Dan,
2 and all Naphtali, and the land of
Ephraim and Manasseh, and all the land
of Judah, to the Western Sea,
3 and the south,† and the Plain of the
valley of Jericho the city of palm trees, to
Zoar.
4 Yahweh said to him, "This is the land
which I swore to Abraham, to Isaac, and
to Jacob, saying, 'I will give it to your
offspring.' I have caused you to see it with
your eyes, but you shall not go over there."
5 So Moses the servant of Yahweh died
there in the land of Moab, according to
Yahweh's word.
6 He buried him in the valley in the land
of Moab opposite Beth Peor, but no man
knows where his tomb is to this day.
7 Moses was one hundred twenty years
old when he died. His eye was not dim,
nor his strength gone.
8 The children of Israel wept for Moses
in the plains of Moab thirty days, until the
days of weeping in the mourning for
Moses were ended.
9 Joshua the son of Nun was full of the
spirit of wisdom, for Moses had laid his
hands on him. The children of Israel
listened to him, and did as Yahweh
commanded Moses.
10 Since then, there has not arisen a
prophet in Israel like Moses, whom
Yahweh knew face to face,
11 in all the signs and the wonders
which Yahweh sent him to do in the land
of Egypt, to Pharaoh, and to all his
servants, and to all his land,
12 and in all the mighty hand, and in all
the awesome deeds, which Moses did in
the sight of all Israel.

† **34:3** or, Negev

The Book of Joshua

1 Now after the death of Moses the servant of Yahweh,† Yahweh spoke to Joshua the son of Nun, Moses' servant, saying,
2 "Moses my servant is dead. Now therefore arise, go across this Jordan, you and all these people, to the land which I am giving to them, even to the children of Israel.
3 I have given you every place that the sole of your foot will tread on, as I told Moses.
4 From the wilderness and this Lebanon even to the great river, the river Euphrates, all the land of the Hittites, and to the great sea toward the going down of the sun, shall be your border.
5 No man will be able to stand before you all the days of your life. As I was with Moses, so I will be with you. I will not fail you nor forsake you.
6 "Be strong and courageous; for you shall cause this people to inherit the land which I swore to their fathers to give them.
7 Only be strong and very courageous. Be careful to observe to do according to all the law which Moses my servant commanded you. Don't turn from it to the right hand or to the left, that you may have good success wherever you go.
8 This book of the law shall not depart from your mouth, but you shall meditate on it day and night, that you may observe to do according to all that is written in it; for then you shall make your way prosperous, and then you shall have good success.
9 Haven't I commanded you? Be strong and courageous. Don't be afraid. Don't be dismayed, for Yahweh your God‡ is with you wherever you go."
10 Then Joshua commanded the officers of the people, saying,
11 "Pass through the middle of the camp, and command the people, saying, 'Prepare food; for within three days you are to pass over this Jordan, to go in to possess the land which Yahweh your God gives you to possess.' "
12 Joshua spoke to the Reubenites, and to the Gadites, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh, saying,
13 "Remember the word which Moses the servant of Yahweh commanded you, saying, 'Yahweh your God gives you rest, and will give you this land.
14 Your wives, your little ones, and your livestock shall live in the land which Moses gave you beyond the Jordan; but you shall pass over before your brothers armed, all the mighty men of valor, and shall help them
15 until Yahweh has given your brothers rest, as he has given you, and they have also possessed the land which Yahweh your God gives them. Then you shall return to the land of your possession and possess it, which Moses the servant of Yahweh gave you beyond the Jordan toward the sunrise.' "
16 They answered Joshua, saying, "All that you have commanded us we will do, and wherever you send us we will go.
17 Just as we listened to Moses in all things, so will we listen to you. Only may Yahweh your God be with you, as he was with Moses.
18 Whoever rebels against your commandment, and doesn't listen to your words in all that you command him shall himself be put to death. Only be strong and courageous."

2

1 Joshua the son of Nun secretly sent two men out of Shittim as spies, saying, "Go, view the land, including Jericho." They went and came into the house of a prostitute whose name was Rahab, and slept there.

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:9** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). † **2:2** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

2 The king of Jericho was told, “Behold,† men of the children of Israel came in here tonight to spy out the land.”
3 Jericho’s king sent to Rahab, saying, “Bring out the men who have come to you, who have entered into your house; for they have come to spy out all the land.”
4 The woman took the two men and hid them. Then she said, “Yes, the men came to me, but I didn’t know where they came from.
5 About the time of the shutting of the gate, when it was dark, the men went out. Where the men went, I don’t know. Pursue them quickly. You may catch up with them.”
6 But she had brought them up to the roof, and hidden them under the stalks of flax which she had laid in order on the roof.
7 The men pursued them along the way to the fords of the Jordan River. As soon as those who pursued them had gone out, they shut the gate.
8 Before they had lain down, she came up to them on the roof.
9 She said to the men, “I know that Yahweh has given you the land, and that the fear of you has fallen upon us, and that all the inhabitants of the land melt away before you.
10 For we have heard how Yahweh dried up the water of the Red Sea before you, when you came out of Egypt; and what you did to the two kings of the Amorites, who were beyond the Jordan, to Sihon and to Og, whom you utterly destroyed.
11 As soon as we had heard it, our hearts melted, and there wasn’t any more spirit in any man, because of you: for Yahweh your God, he is God in heaven above, and on earth beneath.
12 Now therefore, please swear to me by Yahweh, since I have dealt kindly with you, that you also will deal kindly with my father’s house, and give me a true sign;
13 and that you will save alive my father, my mother, my brothers, and my sisters, and all that they have, and will deliver our lives from death.”
14 The men said to her, “Our life for yours, if you don’t talk about this business of ours; and it shall be, when Yahweh gives us the land, that we will deal kindly and truly with you.”
15 Then she let them down by a cord through the window; for her house was on the side of the wall, and she lived on the wall.
16 She said to them, “Go to the mountain, lest the pursuers find you. Hide yourselves there three days, until the pursuers have returned. Afterward, you may go your way.”
17 The men said to her, “We will be guiltless of this your oath which you’ve made us to swear.
18 Behold, when we come into the land, tie this line of scarlet thread in the window which you used to let us down. Gather to yourself into the house your father, your mother, your brothers, and all your father’s household.
19 It shall be that whoever goes out of the doors of your house into the street, his blood will be on his head, and we will be guiltless. Whoever is with you in the house, his blood shall be on our head, if any hand is on him.
20 But if you talk about this business of ours, then we shall be guiltless of your oath which you’ve made us to swear.”
21 She said, “Let it be as you have said.” She sent them away, and they departed. Then she tied the scarlet line in the window.
22 They went and came to the mountain, and stayed there three days, until the pursuers had returned. The pursuers sought them all along the way, but didn’t find them.
23 Then the two men returned, descended from the mountain, crossed the river, and came to Joshua the son of Nun. They told him all that had happened to them.
24 They said to Joshua, “Truly Yahweh has delivered all the land into our hands. Moreover, all the inhabitants of the land melt away before us.”

3

1 Joshua got up early in the morning; and they moved from Shittim and came to the Jordan, he and all the children of

Israel. They camped there before they crossed over.
2 After three days, the officers went through the middle of the camp;
3 and they commanded the people, saying, “When you see the ark of Yahweh your God’s covenant, and the Levitical priests bearing it, then leave your place and follow it.
4 Yet there shall be a space between you and it of about two thousand cubits† by measure—don’t come closer to it—that you may know the way by which you must go; for you have not passed this way before.”
5 Joshua said to the people, “Sanctify yourselves; for tomorrow Yahweh will do wonders among you.”
6 Joshua spoke to the priests, saying, “Take up the ark of the covenant, and cross over before the people.” They took up the ark of the covenant, and went before the people.
7 Yahweh said to Joshua, “Today I will begin to magnify you in the sight of all Israel, that they may know that as I was with Moses, so I will be with you.
8 You shall command the priests who bear the ark of the covenant, saying, ‘When you come to the brink of the waters of the Jordan, you shall stand still in the Jordan.’ ”
9 Joshua said to the children of Israel, “Come here, and hear the words of Yahweh your God.”
10 Joshua said, “By this you shall know that the living God is among you, and that he will without fail drive the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Hivite, the Perizzite, the Girgashite, the Amorite, and the Jebusite out from before you.
11 Behold, the ark of the covenant of the Lord‡ of all the earth passes over before you into the Jordan.
12 Now therefore take twelve men out of the tribes of Israel, for every tribe a man.
13 It shall be that when the soles of the feet of the priests who bear the ark of Yahweh, the Lord of all the earth, rest in the waters of the Jordan, that the waters of the Jordan will be cut off. The waters that come down from above shall stand in one heap.”
14 When the people moved from their tents to pass over the Jordan, the priests who bore the ark of the covenant being before the people,
15 and when those who bore the ark had come to the Jordan, and the feet of the priests who bore the ark had dipped in the edge of the water (for the Jordan overflows all its banks all the time of harvest),
16 the waters which came down from above stood, and rose up in one heap a great way off, at Adam, the city that is beside Zarethan; and those that went down toward the sea of the Arabah, even the Salt Sea, were wholly cut off. Then the people passed over near Jericho.
17 The priests who bore the ark of Yahweh’s covenant stood firm on dry ground in the middle of the Jordan; and all Israel crossed over on dry ground, until all the nation had passed completely over the Jordan.

4

1 When all the nation had completely crossed over the Jordan, Yahweh spoke to Joshua, saying,
2 “Take twelve men out of the people, a man out of every tribe,
3 and command them, saying, ‘Take from out of the middle of the Jordan, out of the place where the priests’ feet stood firm, twelve stones, carry them over with you, and lay them down in the place where you’ll camp tonight.’ ”
4 Then Joshua called the twelve men whom he had prepared of the children of Israel, a man out of every tribe.
5 Joshua said to them, “Cross before the ark of Yahweh your God into the middle of the Jordan, and each of you pick up a stone and put it on your shoulder, according to the number of the tribes of the children of Israel;

† **3:4** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters, so 2,000 cubits is about 920 meters. ‡ **3:11** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai.”

6 that this may be a sign among you, that
when your children ask in the future,
saying, ‘What do you mean by these
stones?’
7 then you shall tell them, ‘Because the
waters of the Jordan were cut off before
the ark of Yahweh’s covenant. When it
crossed over the Jordan, the waters of the
Jordan were cut off. These stones shall be
for a memorial to the children of Israel
forever.’ ”
8 The children of Israel did as Joshua
commanded, and took up twelve stones
out of the middle of the Jordan, as Yahweh
spoke to Joshua, according to the number
of the tribes of the children of Israel. They
carried them over with them to the place
where they camped, and laid them down
there.
9 Joshua set up twelve stones in the
middle of the Jordan, in the place where
the feet of the priests who bore the ark of
the covenant stood; and they are there to
this day.
10 For the priests who bore the ark stood
in the middle of the Jordan until
everything was finished that Yahweh
commanded Joshua to speak to the
people, according to all that Moses
commanded Joshua; and the people
hurried and passed over.
11 When all the people had completely
crossed over, Yahweh’s ark crossed over
with the priests in the presence of the
people.

12 The children of Reuben, and the
children of Gad, and the half-tribe of
Manasseh crossed over armed before the
children of Israel, as Moses spoke to them.
13 About forty thousand men, ready and
armed for war, passed over before
Yahweh to battle, to the plains of Jericho.
14 On that day, Yahweh magnified
Joshua in the sight of all Israel; and they
feared him, as they feared Moses, all the
days of his life.

15 Yahweh spoke to Joshua, saying,
16 “Command the priests who bear the
ark of the covenant, that they come up out
of the Jordan.”
17 Joshua therefore commanded the
priests, saying, “Come up out of the
Jordan!”
18 When the priests who bore the ark of
Yahweh’s covenant had come up out of
the middle of the Jordan, and the soles of
the priests’ feet had been lifted up to the
dry ground, the waters of the Jordan
returned to their place, and went over all
its banks, as before.
19 The people came up out of the Jordan
on the tenth day of the first month, and
encamped in Gilgal, on the east border of
Jericho.
20 Joshua set up those twelve stones,
which they took out of the Jordan, in
Gilgal.
21 He spoke to the children of Israel,
saying, “When your children ask their
fathers in time to come, saying, ‘What do
these stones mean?’
22 Then you shall let your children
know, saying, ‘Israel came over this
Jordan on dry land.
23 For Yahweh your God dried up the
waters of the Jordan from before you until
you had crossed over, as Yahweh your
God did to the Red Sea, which he dried up
from before us, until we had crossed over,
24 that all the peoples of the earth may
know that Yahweh’s hand is mighty, and
that you may fear Yahweh your God
forever.’ ”

5

1 When all the kings of the Amorites,
who were beyond the Jordan westward,
and all the kings of the Canaanites, who
were by the sea, heard how Yahweh had
dried up the waters of the Jordan from
before the children of Israel until we had
crossed over, their heart melted, and
there was no more spirit in them, because
of the children of Israel.
2 At that time, Yahweh said to Joshua,
“Make flint knives, and circumcise again
the sons of Israel the second time.”
3 Joshua made himself flint knives, and
circumcised the sons of Israel at the hill of
the foreskins.
4 This is the reason Joshua circumcised
them: all the people who came out of

Egypt, who were males, even all the men of war, died in the wilderness along the way, after they came out of Egypt.
5 For all the people who came out were circumcised; but all the people who were born in the wilderness along the way as they came out of Egypt had not been circumcised.
6 For the children of Israel walked forty years in the wilderness until all the nation, even the men of war who came out of Egypt, were consumed, because they didn't listen to Yahweh's voice. Yahweh swore to them that he wouldn't let them see the land which Yahweh swore to their fathers that he would give us, a land flowing with milk and honey.
7 Their children, whom he raised up in their place, were circumcised by Joshua, for they were uncircumcised, because they had not circumcised them on the way.
8 When they were done circumcising the whole nation, they stayed in their places in the camp until they were healed.
9 Yahweh said to Joshua, "Today I have rolled away the reproach of Egypt from you." Therefore the name of that place was called Gilgal† to this day.
10 The children of Israel encamped in Gilgal. They kept the Passover on the fourteenth day of the month at evening in the plains of Jericho.
11 They ate unleavened cakes and parched grain of the produce of the land on the next day after the Passover, in the same day.
12 The manna ceased on the next day, after they had eaten of the produce of the land. The children of Israel didn't have manna any more, but they ate of the fruit of the land of Canaan that year.
13 When Joshua was by Jericho, he lifted up his eyes and looked, and behold, a man stood in front of him with his sword drawn in his hand. Joshua went to him and said to him, "Are you for us, or for our enemies?"
14 He said, "No; but I have come now as commander of Yahweh's army."

Joshua fell on his face to the earth, and worshiped, and asked him, "What does my lord say to his servant?"
15 The prince of Yahweh's army said to Joshua, "Take off your sandals, for the place on which you stand is holy." Joshua did so.

6

1 Now Jericho was tightly shut up because of the children of Israel. No one went out, and no one came in.
2 Yahweh said to Joshua, "Behold, I have given Jericho into your hand, with its king and the mighty men of valor.
3 All of your men of war shall march around the city, going around the city once. You shall do this six days.
4 Seven priests shall bear seven trumpets of rams' horns before the ark. On the seventh day, you shall march around the city seven times, and the priests shall blow the trumpets.
5 It shall be that when they make a long blast with the ram's horn, and when you hear the sound of the trumpet, all the people shall shout with a great shout; then the city wall will fall down flat, and the people shall go up, every man straight in front of him."
6 Joshua the son of Nun called the priests, and said to them, "Take up the ark of the covenant, and let seven priests bear seven trumpets of rams' horns before Yahweh's ark."
7 They said to the people, "Advance! March around the city, and let the armed men pass on before Yahweh's ark."
8 It was so, that when Joshua had spoken to the people, the seven priests bearing the seven trumpets of rams' horns before Yahweh advanced and blew the trumpets, and the ark of Yahweh's covenant followed them.
9 The armed men went before the priests who blew the trumpets, and the ark went after them. The trumpets sounded as they went.
10 Joshua commanded the people, saying, "You shall not shout nor let your

† **5:9** "Gilgal" sounds like the Hebrew for "roll."

voice be heard, neither shall any word proceed out of your mouth until the day I tell you to shout. Then you shall shout."
11 So he caused Yahweh's ark to go around the city, circling it once. Then they came into the camp, and stayed in the camp.
12 Joshua rose early in the morning, and the priests took up Yahweh's ark.
13 The seven priests bearing the seven trumpets of rams' horns in front of Yahweh's ark went on continually, and blew the trumpets. The armed men went in front of them. The rear guard came after Yahweh's ark. The trumpets sounded as they went.
14 The second day they marched around the city once, and returned into the camp. They did this six days.
15 On the seventh day, they rose early at the dawning of the day, and marched around the city in the same way seven times. On this day only they marched around the city seven times.
16 At the seventh time, when the priests blew the trumpets, Joshua said to the people, "Shout, for Yahweh has given you the city!
17 The city shall be devoted, even it and all that is in it, to Yahweh. Only Rahab the prostitute shall live, she and all who are with her in the house, because she hid the messengers that we sent.
18 But as for you, only keep yourselves from what is devoted to destruction, lest when you have devoted it, you take of the devoted thing; so you would make the camp of Israel accursed and trouble it.
19 But all the silver, gold, and vessels of bronze and iron are holy to Yahweh. They shall come into Yahweh's treasury."
20 So the people shouted and the priests blew the trumpets. When the people heard the sound of the trumpet, the people shouted with a great shout, and the wall fell down flat, so that the people went up into the city, every man straight in front of him, and they took the city.
21 They utterly destroyed all that was in the city, both man and woman, both young and old, and ox, sheep, and donkey, with the edge of the sword.
22 Joshua said to the two men who had spied out the land, "Go into the prostitute's house, and bring the woman and all that she has out from there, as you swore to her."
23 The young men who were spies went in, and brought out Rahab with her father, her mother, her brothers, and all that she had. They also brought out all of her relatives, and they set them outside of the camp of Israel.
24 They burned the city with fire, and all that was in it. Only they put the silver, the gold, and the vessels of bronze and of iron into the treasury of Yahweh's house.
25 But Rahab the prostitute, her father's household, and all that she had, Joshua saved alive. She lives in the middle of Israel to this day, because she hid the messengers whom Joshua sent to spy out Jericho.
26 Joshua commanded them with an oath at that time, saying, "Cursed is the man before Yahweh who rises up and builds this city Jericho. With the loss of his firstborn he will lay its foundation, and with the loss of his youngest son he will set up its gates."
27 So Yahweh was with Joshua; and his fame was in all the land.

7

1 But the children of Israel committed a trespass in the devoted things; for Achan, the son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, took some of the devoted things. Therefore Yahweh's anger burned against the children of Israel.
2 Joshua sent men from Jericho to Ai, which is beside Beth Aven, on the east side of Bethel, and spoke to them, saying, "Go up and spy out the land."
The men went up and spied out Ai.
3 They returned to Joshua, and said to him, "Don't let all the people go up, but let about two or three thousand men go up and strike Ai. Don't make all the people to toil there, for there are only a few of them."

4 So about three thousand men of the people went up there, and they fled before the men of Ai.
5 The men of Ai struck about thirty-six men of them. They chased them from before the gate even to Shebarim, and struck them at the descent. The hearts of the people melted, and became like water.
6 Joshua tore his clothes, and fell to the earth on his face before Yahweh's ark until the evening, he and the elders of Israel; and they put dust on their heads.
7 Joshua said, "Alas, Lord Yahweh, why have you brought this people over the Jordan at all, to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites, to cause us to perish? I wish that we had been content and lived beyond the Jordan!
8 Oh, Lord, what shall I say, after Israel has turned their backs before their enemies?
9 For the Canaanites and all the inhabitants of the land will hear of it, and will surround us, and cut off our name from the earth. What will you do for your great name?"
10 Yahweh said to Joshua, "Get up! Why have you fallen on your face like that?
11 Israel has sinned. Yes, they have even transgressed my covenant which I commanded them. Yes, they have even taken some of the devoted things, and have also stolen, and also deceived. They have even put it among their own stuff.
12 Therefore the children of Israel can't stand before their enemies. They turn their backs before their enemies, because they have become devoted for destruction. I will not be with you any more, unless you destroy the devoted things from among you.
13 Get up! Sanctify the people, and say, 'Sanctify yourselves for tomorrow, for Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, "There is a devoted thing among you, Israel. You cannot stand before your enemies until you take away the devoted thing from among you."
14 In the morning therefore you shall be brought near by your tribes. It shall be that the tribe which Yahweh selects shall come near by families. The family which Yahweh selects shall come near by households. The household which Yahweh selects shall come near man by man.
15 It shall be, that he who is taken with the devoted thing shall be burned with fire, he and all that he has, because he has transgressed Yahweh's covenant, and because he has done a disgraceful thing in Israel.' "
16 So Joshua rose up early in the morning and brought Israel near by their tribes. The tribe of Judah was selected.
17 He brought near the family of Judah, and he selected the family of the Zerahites. He brought near the family of the Zerahites man by man, and Zabdi was selected.
18 He brought near his household man by man, and Achan, the son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, was selected.
19 Joshua said to Achan, "My son, please give glory to Yahweh, the God of Israel, and make confession to him. Tell me now what you have done! Don't hide it from me!"
20 Achan answered Joshua, and said, "I have truly sinned against Yahweh, the God of Israel, and this is what I have done.
21 When I saw among the plunder a beautiful Babylonian robe, two hundred shekels† of silver, and a wedge of gold weighing fifty shekels, then I coveted them and took them. Behold, they are hidden in the ground in the middle of my tent, with the silver under it."
22 So Joshua sent messengers, and they ran to the tent. Behold, it was hidden in his tent, with the silver under it.
23 They took them from the middle of the tent, and brought them to Joshua and to all the children of Israel. They laid them down before Yahweh.
24 Joshua, and all Israel with him, took Achan the son of Zerah, the silver, the robe, the wedge of gold, his sons, his daughters, his cattle, his donkeys, his sheep, his tent, and all that he had; and

† **7:21** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

they brought them up to the valley of Achor.
25 Joshua said, “Why have you troubled us? Yahweh will trouble you today.” All Israel stoned him with stones, and they burned them with fire and stoned them with stones.
26 They raised over him a great heap of stones that remains to this day. Yahweh turned from the fierceness of his anger. Therefore the name of that place was called “The valley of Achor” to this day.

8

1 Yahweh said to Joshua, “Don’t be afraid, and don’t be dismayed. Take all the warriors with you, and arise, go up to Ai. Behold, I have given into your hand the king of Ai, with his people, his city, and his land.
2 You shall do to Ai and her king as you did to Jericho and her king, except you shall take its goods and its livestock for yourselves. Set an ambush for the city behind it.”
3 So Joshua arose, with all the warriors, to go up to Ai. Joshua chose thirty thousand men, the mighty men of valor, and sent them out by night.
4 He commanded them, saying, “Behold, you shall lie in ambush against the city, behind the city. Don’t go very far from the city, but all of you be ready.
5 I and all the people who are with me will approach the city. It shall happen, when they come out against us, as at the first, that we will flee before them.
6 They will come out after us until we have drawn them away from the city; for they will say, ‘They flee before us, like the first time.’ So we will flee before them,
7 and you shall rise up from the ambush, and take possession of the city; for Yahweh your God will deliver it into your hand.
8 It shall be, when you have seized the city, that you shall set the city on fire. You shall do this according to Yahweh’s word. Behold, I have commanded you.”
9 Joshua sent them out; and they went to set up the ambush, and stayed between Bethel and Ai on the west side of Ai; but Joshua stayed among the people that night.
10 Joshua rose up early in the morning, mustered the people, and went up, he and the elders of Israel, before the people to Ai.
11 All the people, even the men of war who were with him, went up and came near, and came before the city and encamped on the north side of Ai. Now there was a valley between him and Ai.
12 He took about five thousand men, and set them in ambush between Bethel and Ai, on the west side of the city.
13 So they set the people, even all the army who was on the north of the city, and their ambush on the west of the city; and Joshua went that night into the middle of the valley.
14 When the king of Ai saw it, they hurried and rose up early, and the men of the city went out against Israel to battle, he and all his people, at the time appointed, before the Arabah; but he didn’t know that there was an ambush against him behind the city.
15 Joshua and all Israel made as if they were beaten before them, and fled by the way of the wilderness.
16 All the people who were in the city were called together to pursue after them. They pursued Joshua, and were drawn away from the city.
17 There was not a man left in Ai or Bethel who didn’t go out after Israel. They left the city open, and pursued Israel.
18 Yahweh said to Joshua, “Stretch out the javelin that is in your hand toward Ai, for I will give it into your hand.”

Joshua stretched out the javelin that was in his hand toward the city.
19 The ambush arose quickly out of their place, and they ran as soon as he had stretched out his hand and entered into the city and took it. They hurried and set the city on fire.
20 When the men of Ai looked behind them, they saw, and behold, the smoke of the city ascended up to heaven, and they had no power to flee this way or that way.

The people who fled to the wilderness turned back on the pursuers.
21 When Joshua and all Israel saw that the ambush had taken the city, and that the smoke of the city ascended, then they turned back and killed the men of Ai.
22 The others came out of the city against them, so they were in the middle of Israel, some on this side, and some on that side. They struck them, so that they let none of them remain or escape.
23 They captured the king of Ai alive, and brought him to Joshua.
24 When Israel had finished killing all the inhabitants of Ai in the field, in the wilderness in which they pursued them, and they had all fallen by the edge of the sword until they were consumed, all Israel returned to Ai and struck it with the edge of the sword.
25 All that fell that day, both of men and women, were twelve thousand, even all the people of Ai.
26 For Joshua didn't draw back his hand, with which he stretched out the javelin, until he had utterly destroyed all the inhabitants of Ai.
27 Israel took for themselves only the livestock and the goods of that city, according to Yahweh's word which he commanded Joshua.
28 So Joshua burned Ai and made it a heap forever, even a desolation, to this day.
29 He hanged the king of Ai on a tree until the evening. At sundown, Joshua commanded, and they took his body down from the tree and threw it at the entrance of the gate of the city, and raised a great heap of stones on it that remains to this day.
30 Then Joshua built an altar to Yahweh, the God of Israel, on Mount Ebal,
31 as Moses the servant of Yahweh commanded the children of Israel, as it is written in the book of the law of Moses: an altar of uncut stones, on which no one had lifted up any iron. They offered burnt offerings on it to Yahweh and sacrificed peace offerings.
32 He wrote there on the stones a copy of Moses' law, which he wrote in the presence of the children of Israel.
33 All Israel, with their elders, officers, and judges, stood on both sides of the ark before the Levitical priests, who carried the ark of Yahweh's covenant, the foreigner as well as the native; half of them in front of Mount Gerizim, and half of them in front of Mount Ebal, as Moses the servant of Yahweh had commanded at the first, that they should bless the people of Israel.
34 Afterward he read all the words of the law, the blessing and the curse, according to all that is written in the book of the law.
35 There was not a word of all that Moses commanded which Joshua didn't read before all the assembly of Israel, with the women, the little ones, and the foreigners who were among them.

9

1 When all the kings who were beyond the Jordan, in the hill country, and in the lowland, and on all the shore of the great sea in front of Lebanon, the Hittite, the Amorite, the Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite, heard of it
2 they gathered themselves together to fight with Joshua and with Israel, with one accord.
3 But when the inhabitants of Gibeon heard what Joshua had done to Jericho and to Ai,
4 they also resorted to a ruse, and went and made as if they had been ambassadors, and took old sacks on their donkeys, and old, torn-up and bound up wineskins,
5 and old and patched sandals on their feet, and wore old garments. All the bread of their food supply was dry and moldy.
6 They went to Joshua at the camp at Gilgal, and said to him and to the men of Israel, "We have come from a far country. Now therefore make a covenant with us."
7 The men of Israel said to the Hivites, "What if you live among us? How could we make a covenant with you?"
8 They said to Joshua, "We are your servants."
Joshua said to them, "Who are you? Where do you come from?"

9 They said to him, “Your servants have
come from a very far country because of
the name of Yahweh your God; for we
have heard of his fame, all that he did in
Egypt,
10 and all that he did to the two kings of
the Amorites who were beyond the
Jordan, to Sihon king of Heshbon and to
Og king of Bashan, who was at Ashtaroth.
11 Our elders and all the inhabitants of
our country spoke to us, saying, ‘Take
supplies in your hand for the journey, and
go to meet them. Tell them, “We are your
servants. Now make a covenant with us.” ’
12 This our bread we took hot for our
supplies out of our houses on the day we
went out to go to you; but now, behold, it
is dry, and has become moldy.
13 These wineskins, which we filled,
were new; and behold, they are torn.
These our garments and our sandals have
become old because of the very long
journey.”
14 The men sampled their provisions,
and didn’t ask counsel from Yahweh’s
mouth.
15 Joshua made peace with them, and
made a covenant with them, to let them
live. The princes of the congregation
swore to them.
16 At the end of three days after they had
made a covenant with them, they heard
that they were their neighbors, and that
they lived among them.
17 The children of Israel traveled and
came to their cities on the third day. Now
their cities were Gibeon, Chephirah,
Beeroth, and Kiriath Jearim.
18 The children of Israel didn’t strike
them, because the princes of the
congregation had sworn to them by
Yahweh, the God of Israel. All the
congregation murmured against the
princes.
19 But all the princes said to all the
congregation, “We have sworn to them by
Yahweh, the God of Israel. Now therefore
we may not touch them.
20 We will do this to them, and let them
live; lest wrath be on us, because of the
oath which we swore to them.”
21 The princes said to them, “Let them
live.” So they became wood cutters and
drawers of water for all the congregation,
as the princes had spoken to them.
22 Joshua called for them, and he spoke
to them, saying, “Why have you deceived
us, saying, ‘We are very far from you,’
when you live among us?
23 Now therefore you are cursed, and
some of you will never fail to be slaves,
both wood cutters and drawers of water
for the house of my God.”
24 They answered Joshua, and said,
“Because your servants were certainly
told how Yahweh your God commanded
his servant Moses to give you all the land,
and to destroy all the inhabitants of the
land from before you. Therefore we were
very afraid for our lives because of you,
and have done this thing.
25 Now, behold, we are in your hand. Do
to us as it seems good and right to you to
do.”
26 He did so to them, and delivered them
out of the hand of the children of Israel, so
that they didn’t kill them.
27 That day Joshua made them wood
cutters and drawers of water for the
congregation and for Yahweh’s altar to
this day, in the place which he should
choose.

10

1 Now when Adoni-Zedek king of
Jerusalem heard how Joshua had taken
Ai, and had utterly destroyed it; as he had
done to Jericho and her king, so he had
done to Ai and her king; and how the
inhabitants of Gibeon had made peace
with Israel, and were among them,
2 they were very afraid, because Gibeon
was a great city, as one of the royal cities,
and because it was greater than Ai, and all
its men were mighty.
3 Therefore Adoni-Zedek king of
Jerusalem sent to Hoham king of Hebron,
Piram king of Jarmuth, Japhia king of
Lachish, and Debir king of Eglon, saying,
4 “Come up to me and help me. Let’s
strike Gibeon; for they have made peace
with Joshua and with the children of
Israel.”

5 Therefore the five kings of the
Amorites, the king of Jerusalem, the king
of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of
Lachish, and the king of Eglon, gathered
themselves together and went up, they
and all their armies, and encamped
against Gibeon, and made war against it.
6 The men of Gibeon sent to Joshua at
the camp at Gilgal, saying, “Don’t abandon
your servants! Come up to us quickly and
save us! Help us; for all the kings of the
Amorites that dwell in the hill country
have gathered together against us.”
7 So Joshua went up from Gilgal, he and
the whole army with him, including all
the mighty men of valor.
8 Yahweh said to Joshua, “Don’t fear
them, for I have delivered them into your
hands. Not a man of them will stand
before you.”
9 Joshua therefore came to them
suddenly. He marched from Gilgal all
night.
10 Yahweh confused them before Israel.
He killed them with a great slaughter at
Gibeon, and chased them by the way of
the ascent of Beth Horon, and struck them
to Azekah and to Makkedah.
11 As they fled from before Israel, while
they were at the descent of Beth Horon,
Yahweh hurled down great stones from
the sky on them to Azekah, and they died.
There were more who died from the
hailstones than those whom the children
of Israel killed with the sword.
12 Then Joshua spoke to Yahweh in the
day when Yahweh delivered up the
Amorites before the children of Israel. He
said in the sight of Israel, “Sun, stand still
on Gibeon! You, moon, stop in the valley
of Aijalon!”
13 The sun stood still, and the moon
stayed, until the nation had avenged
themselves of their enemies. Isn’t this
written in the book of Jashar? The sun
stayed in the middle of the sky, and didn’t
hurry to go down about a whole day.
14 There was no day like that before it or
after it, that Yahweh listened to the voice
of a man; for Yahweh fought for Israel.
15 Joshua returned, and all Israel with
him, to the camp to Gilgal.
16 These five kings fled, and hid
themselves in the cave at Makkedah.
17 Joshua was told, saying, “The five
kings have been found, hidden in the cave
at Makkedah.”
18 Joshua said, “Roll large stones to
cover the cave’s entrance, and set men by
it to guard them;
19 but don’t stay there. Pursue your
enemies, and attack them from the rear.
Don’t allow them to enter into their cities;
for Yahweh your God has delivered them
into your hand.”
20 When Joshua and the children of
Israel had finished killing them with a
very great slaughter until they were
consumed, and the remnant which
remained of them had entered into the
fortified cities,
21 all the people returned to the camp to
Joshua at Makkedah in peace. None
moved his tongue against any of the
children of Israel.
22 Then Joshua said, “Open the cave
entrance, and bring those five kings out of
the cave to me.”
23 They did so, and brought those five
kings out of the cave to him: the king of
Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of
Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, and the king
of Eglon.
24 When they brought those kings out to
Joshua, Joshua called for all the men of
Israel, and said to the chiefs of the men of
war who went with him, “Come near. Put
your feet on the necks of these kings.”
They came near, and put their feet on
their necks.
25 Joshua said to them, “Don’t be afraid,
nor be dismayed. Be strong and
courageous, for Yahweh will do this to all
your enemies against whom you fight.”
26 Afterward Joshua struck them, put
them to death, and hanged them on five
trees. They were hanging on the trees
until the evening.
27 At the time of the going down of the
sun, Joshua commanded, and they took
them down off the trees, and threw them
into the cave in which they had hidden
themselves, and laid great stones on the

mouth of the cave, which remain to this very day.

28 Joshua took Makkedah on that day, and struck it with the edge of the sword, with its king. He utterly destroyed it and all the souls who were in it. He left no one remaining. He did to the king of Makkedah as he had done to the king of Jericho.

29 Joshua passed from Makkedah, and all Israel with him, to Libnah, and fought against Libnah.

30 Yahweh delivered it also, with its king, into the hand of Israel. He struck it with the edge of the sword, and all the souls who were in it. He left no one remaining in it. He did to its king as he had done to the king of Jericho.

31 Joshua passed from Libnah, and all Israel with him, to Lachish, and encamped against it, and fought against it.

32 Yahweh delivered Lachish into the hand of Israel. He took it on the second day, and struck it with the edge of the sword, with all the souls who were in it, according to all that he had done to Libnah.

33 Then Horam king of Gezer came up to help Lachish; and Joshua struck him and his people, until he had left him no one remaining.

34 Joshua passed from Lachish, and all Israel with him, to Eglon; and they encamped against it and fought against it.

35 They took it on that day, and struck it with the edge of the sword. He utterly destroyed all the souls who were in it that day, according to all that he had done to Lachish.

36 Joshua went up from Eglon, and all Israel with him, to Hebron; and they fought against it.

37 They took it, and struck it with the edge of the sword, with its king and all its cities, and all the souls who were in it. He left no one remaining, according to all that he had done to Eglon; but he utterly destroyed it, and all the souls who were in it.

38 Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, to Debir, and fought against it.

39 He took it, with its king and all its cities. They struck them with the edge of the sword, and utterly destroyed all the souls who were in it. He left no one remaining. As he had done to Hebron, so he did to Debir, and to its king; as he had done also to Libnah, and to its king.

40 So Joshua struck all the land, the hill country, the South, the lowland, the slopes, and all their kings. He left no one remaining, but he utterly destroyed all that breathed, as Yahweh, the God of Israel, commanded.

41 Joshua struck them from Kadesh Barnea even to Gaza, and all the country of Goshen, even to Gibeon.

42 Joshua took all these kings and their land at one time because Yahweh, the God of Israel, fought for Israel.

43 Joshua returned, and all Israel with him, to the camp to Gilgal.

11

1 When Jabin king of Hazor heard of it, he sent to Jobab king of Madon, to the king of Shimron, to the king of Achshaph,

2 and to the kings who were on the north, in the hill country, in the Arabah south of Chinneroth, in the lowland, and in the heights of Dor on the west,

3 to the Canaanite on the east and on the west, the Amorite, the Hittite, the Perizzite, the Jebusite in the hill country, and the Hivite under Hermon in the land of Mizpah.

4 They went out, they and all their armies with them, many people, even as the sand that is on the seashore in multitude, with very many horses and chariots.

5 All these kings met together; and they came and encamped together at the waters of Merom, to fight with Israel.

6 Yahweh said to Joshua, “Don’t be afraid because of them; for tomorrow at this time, I will deliver them up all slain before Israel. You shall hamstring their horses and burn their chariots with fire.”

7 So Joshua came suddenly, with all the warriors, against them by the waters of Merom, and attacked them.

8 Yahweh delivered them into the hand
of Israel, and they struck them, and
chased them to great Sidon, and to
Misrephoth Maim, and to the valley of
Mizpah eastward. They struck them until
they left them no one remaining.
9 Joshua did to them as Yahweh told
him. He hamstrung their horses and
burned their chariots with fire.
10 Joshua turned back at that time, and
took Hazor, and struck its king with the
sword; for Hazor used to be the head of all
those kingdoms.
11 They struck all the souls who were in
it with the edge of the sword, utterly
destroying them. There was no one left
who breathed. He burned Hazor with fire.
12 Joshua captured all the cities of those
kings, with their kings, and he struck
them with the edge of the sword, and
utterly destroyed them, as Moses the
servant of Yahweh commanded.
13 But as for the cities that stood on their
mounds, Israel burned none of them,
except Hazor only. Joshua burned that.
14 The children of Israel took all the
plunder of these cities, with the livestock,
as plunder for themselves; but every man
they struck with the edge of the sword,
until they had destroyed them. They
didn't leave any who breathed.
15 As Yahweh commanded Moses his
servant, so Moses commanded Joshua.
Joshua did so. He left nothing undone of
all that Yahweh commanded Moses.
16 So Joshua captured all that land, the
hill country, all the South, all the land of
Goshen, the lowland, the Arabah, the hill
country of Israel, and the lowland of the
same,
17 from Mount Halak, that goes up to
Seir, even to Baal Gad in the valley of
Lebanon under Mount Hermon. He took
all their kings, struck them, and put them
to death.
18 Joshua made war a long time with all
those kings.
19 There was not a city that made peace
with the children of Israel, except the
Hivites, the inhabitants of Gibeon. They
took all in battle.
20 For it was of Yahweh to harden their
hearts, to come against Israel in battle,
that he might utterly destroy them, that
they might have no favor, but that he
might destroy them, as Yahweh
commanded Moses.
21 Joshua came at that time, and cut off
the Anakim from the hill country, from
Hebron, from Debir, from Anab, and from
all the hill country of Judah, and from all
the hill country of Israel. Joshua utterly
destroyed them with their cities.
22 There were none of the Anakim left in
the land of the children of Israel. Only in
Gaza, in Gath, and in Ashdod, did some
remain.
23 So Joshua took the whole land,
according to all that Yahweh spoke to
Moses; and Joshua gave it for an
inheritance to Israel according to their
divisions by their tribes. Then the land
had rest from war.

12

1 Now these are the kings of the land,
whom the children of Israel struck, and
possessed their land beyond the Jordan
toward the sunrise, from the valley of the
Arnon to Mount Hermon, and all the
Arabah eastward:
2 Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived
in Heshbon, and ruled from Aroer, which
is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon,
and the middle of the valley, and half
Gilead, even to the river Jabbok, the
border of the children of Ammon;
3 and the Arabah to the sea of
Chinneroth, eastward, and to the sea of
the Arabah, even the Salt Sea, eastward,
the way to Beth Jeshimoth; and on the
south, under the slopes of Pisgah:
4 and the border of Og king of Bashan, of
the remnant of the Rephaim, who lived at
Ashtaroth and at Edrei,
5 and ruled in Mount Hermon, and in
Salecah, and in all Bashan, to the border
of the Geshurites and the Maacathites,
and half Gilead, the border of Sihon king
of Heshbon.
6 Moses the servant of Yahweh and the
children of Israel struck them. Moses the
servant of Yahweh gave it for a possession
to the Reubenites, and the Gadites, and
the half-tribe of Manasseh.

7 These are the kings of the land whom
Joshua and the children of Israel struck
beyond the Jordan westward, from Baal
Gad in the valley of Lebanon even to
Mount Halak, that goes up to Seir. Joshua
gave it to the tribes of Israel for a
possession according to their divisions;
8 in the hill country, and in the lowland,
and in the Arabah, and in the slopes, and
in the wilderness, and in the South; the
Hittite, the Amorite, and the Canaanite,
the Perizzite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite:
9 the king of Jericho, one;
the king of Ai, which is beside Bethel, one;
10 the king of Jerusalem, one;
the king of Hebron, one;
11 the king of Jarmuth, one;
the king of Lachish, one;
12 the king of Eglon, one;
the king of Gezer, one;
13 the king of Debir, one;
the king of Geder, one;
14 the king of Hormah, one;
the king of Arad, one;
15 the king of Libnah, one;
the king of Adullam, one;
16 the king of Makkedah, one;
the king of Bethel, one;
17 the king of Tappuah, one;
the king of Hepher, one;
18 the king of Aphek, one;
the king of Lassharon, one;
19 the king of Madon, one;
the king of Hazor, one;
20 the king of Shimron Meron, one;
the king of Achshaph, one;
21 the king of Taanach, one;
the king of Megiddo, one;
22 the king of Kedesh, one;
the king of Jokneam in Carmel, one;
23 the king of Dor in the height of Dor, one;
the king of Goiim in Gilgal, one;
24 the king of Tirzah, one:
all the kings thirty-one.

13

1 Now Joshua was old and well
advanced in years. Yahweh said to him,
“You are old and advanced in years, and
there remains yet very much land to be
possessed.

2 “This is the land that still remains: all
the regions of the Philistines, and all the
Geshurites;
3 from the Shihor, which is before Egypt,
even to the border of Ekron northward,
which is counted as Canaanite; the five
lords of the Philistines; the Gazites, and
the Ashdodites, the Ashkelonites, the
Gittites, and the Ekronites; also the Avvim,
4 on the south; all the land of the
Canaanites, and Mearah that belongs to
the Sidonians, to Aphek, to the border of
the Amorites;
5 and the land of the Gebalites, and all
Lebanon, toward the sunrise, from Baal
Gad under Mount Hermon to the entrance
of Hamath;
6 all the inhabitants of the hill country
from Lebanon to Misrephoth Maim, even
all the Sidonians. I will drive them out
from before the children of Israel. Just
allocate it to Israel for an inheritance, as I
have commanded you.
7 Now therefore divide this land for an
inheritance to the nine tribes and the
half-tribe of Manasseh.”
8 With him the Reubenites and the
Gadites received their inheritance, which
Moses gave them, beyond the Jordan
eastward, even as Moses the servant of
Yahweh gave them:
9 from Aroer, that is on the edge of the
valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in
the middle of the valley, and all the plain
of Medeba to Dibon;
10 and all the cities of Sihon king of the
Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon, to the
border of the children of Ammon;
11 and Gilead, and the border of the
Geshurites and Maacathites, and all
Mount Hermon, and all Bashan to
Salecah;
12 all the kingdom of Og in Bashan, who
reigned in Ashtaroth and in Edrei (who
was left of the remnant of the Rephaim);
for Moses attacked these, and drove them
out.
13 Nevertheless the children of Israel
didn’t drive out the Geshurites, nor the
Maacathites: but Geshur and Maacath
live within Israel to this day.

14 Only he gave no inheritance to the tribe of Levi. The offerings of Yahweh, the God of Israel, made by fire are his inheritance, as he spoke to him.
15 Moses gave to the tribe of the children of Reuben according to their families.
16 Their border was from Aroer, that is on the edge of the valley of the Arnon, and the city that is in the middle of the valley, and all the plain by Medeba;
17 Heshbon, and all its cities that are in the plain; Dibon, Bamoth Baal, Beth Baal Meon,
18 Jahaz, Kedemoth, Mephaath,
19 Kiriathaim, Sibmah, Zereth Shahar in the mount of the valley,
20 Beth Peor, the slopes of Pisgah, Beth Jeshimoth,
21 all the cities of the plain, and all the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon, whom Moses struck with the chiefs of Midian, Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba, the princes of Sihon, who lived in the land.
22 The children of Israel also killed Balaam the son of Beor, the soothsayer, with the sword, among the rest of their slain.
23 The border of the children of Reuben was the bank of the Jordan. This was the inheritance of the children of Reuben according to their families, the cities and its villages.
24 Moses gave to the tribe of Gad, to the children of Gad, according to their families.
25 Their border was Jazer, and all the cities of Gilead, and half the land of the children of Ammon, to Aroer that is near Rabbah;
26 and from Heshbon to Ramath Mizpeh, and Betonim; and from Mahanaim to the border of Debir;
27 and in the valley, Beth Haram, Beth Nimrah, Succoth, and Zaphon, the rest of the kingdom of Sihon king of Heshbon, the Jordan's bank, to the uttermost part of the sea of Chinnereth beyond the Jordan eastward.
28 This is the inheritance of the children of Gad according to their families, the cities and its villages.
29 Moses gave an inheritance to the half-tribe of Manasseh. It was for the half-tribe of the children of Manasseh according to their families.
30 Their border was from Mahanaim, all Bashan, all the kingdom of Og king of Bashan, and all the villages of Jair, which are in Bashan, sixty cities.
31 Half Gilead, Ashtaroth, and Edrei, the cities of the kingdom of Og in Bashan, were for the children of Machir the son of Manasseh, even for the half of the children of Machir according to their families.
32 These are the inheritances which Moses distributed in the plains of Moab, beyond the Jordan at Jericho, eastward.
33 But Moses gave no inheritance to the tribe of Levi. Yahweh, the God of Israel, is their inheritance, as he spoke to them.

14

1 These are the inheritances which the children of Israel took in the land of Canaan, which Eleazar the priest, Joshua the son of Nun, and the heads of the fathers' houses of the tribes of the children of Israel, distributed to them,
2 by the lot of their inheritance, as Yahweh commanded by Moses, for the nine tribes, and for the half-tribe.
3 For Moses had given the inheritance of the two tribes and the half-tribe beyond the Jordan; but to the Levites he gave no inheritance among them.
4 For the children of Joseph were two tribes, Manasseh and Ephraim. They gave no portion to the Levites in the land, except cities to dwell in, with their pasture lands for their livestock and for their property.
5 The children of Israel did as Yahweh commanded Moses, and they divided the land.
6 Then the children of Judah came near to Joshua in Gilgal. Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite said to him, "You know the thing that Yahweh spoke to Moses the man of God concerning me and concerning you in Kadesh Barnea.
7 I was forty years old when Moses the servant of Yahweh sent me from Kadesh

Barnea to spy out the land. I brought him word again as it was in my heart.
8 Nevertheless, my brothers who went up with me made the heart of the people melt; but I wholly followed Yahweh my God.
9 Moses swore on that day, saying, 'Surely the land where you walked shall be an inheritance to you and to your children forever, because you have wholly followed Yahweh my God.'
10 "Now, behold, Yahweh has kept me alive, as he spoke, these forty-five years, from the time that Yahweh spoke this word to Moses, while Israel walked in the wilderness. Now, behold, I am eighty-five years old, today.
11 As yet I am as strong today as I was in the day that Moses sent me. As my strength was then, even so is my strength now for war, to go out and to come in.
12 Now therefore give me this hill country, of which Yahweh spoke in that day; for you heard in that day how the Anakim were there, and great and fortified cities. It may be that Yahweh will be with me, and I shall drive them out, as Yahweh said."
13 Joshua blessed him; and he gave Hebron to Caleb the son of Jephunneh for an inheritance.
14 Therefore Hebron became the inheritance of Caleb the son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite to this day, because he followed Yahweh, the God of Israel wholeheartedly.
15 Now the name of Hebron before was Kiriath Arba, after the greatest man among the Anakim. Then the land had rest from war.

15

1 The lot for the tribe of the children of Judah according to their families was to the border of Edom, even to the wilderness of Zin southward, at the uttermost part of the south.
2 Their south border was from the uttermost part of the Salt Sea, from the bay that looks southward;
3 and it went out southward of the ascent of Akrabbim, and passed along to Zin, and went up by the south of Kadesh Barnea, and passed along by Hezron, went up to Addar, and turned toward Karka;
4 and it passed along to Azmon, went out at the brook of Egypt; and the border ended at the sea. This shall be your south border.
5 The east border was the Salt Sea, even to the end of the Jordan. The border of the north quarter was from the bay of the sea at the end of the Jordan.
6 The border went up to Beth Hoglah, and passed along by the north of Beth Arabah; and the border went up to the stone of Bohan the son of Reuben.
7 The border went up to Debir from the valley of Achor, and so northward, looking toward Gilgal, that faces the ascent of Adummim, which is on the south side of the river. The border passed along to the waters of En Shemesh, and ended at En Rogel.
8 The border went up by the valley of the son of Hinnom to the side of the Jebusite (also called Jerusalem) southward; and the border went up to the top of the mountain that lies before the valley of Hinnom westward, which is at the farthest part of the valley of Rephaim northward.
9 The border extended from the top of the mountain to the spring of the waters of Nephtoah, and went out to the cities of Mount Ephron; and the border extended to Baalah (also called Kiriath Jearim);
10 and the border turned about from Baalah westward to Mount Seir, and passed along to the side of Mount Jearim (also called Chesalon) on the north, and went down to Beth Shemesh, and passed along by Timnah;
11 and the border went out to the side of Ekron northward; and the border extended to Shikkeron, and passed along to Mount Baalah, and went out at Jabneel; and the goings out of the border were at the sea.
12 The west border was to the shore of the great sea. This is the border of the children of Judah according to their families.

13 He gave to Caleb the son of
Jephunneh a portion among the children
of Judah, according to the commandment
of Yahweh to Joshua, even Kiriath Arba,
named after the father of Anak (also
called Hebron).
14 Caleb drove out the three sons of
Anak: Sheshai, and Ahiman, and Talmai,
the children of Anak.
15 He went up against the inhabitants of
Debir: now the name of Debir before was
Kiriath Sepher.
16 Caleb said, “He who strikes Kiriath
Sepher, and takes it, to him I will give
Achsah my daughter as wife.”
17 Othniel the son of Kenaz, the brother
of Caleb, took it: and he gave him Achsah
his daughter as wife.
18 When she came, she had him ask her
father for a field. She got off her donkey,
and Caleb said, “What do you want?”
19 She said, “Give me a blessing. Because
you have set me in the land of the South,
give me also springs of water.”
So he gave her the upper springs and
the lower springs.
20 This is the inheritance of the tribe of
the children of Judah according to their
families.
21 The farthest cities of the tribe of the
children of Judah toward the border of
Edom in the South were Kabzeel, Eder,
Jagur,
22 Kinah, Dimonah, Adadah,
23 Kedesh, Hazor, Ithnan,
24 Ziph, Telem, Bealoth,
25 Hazor Hadattah, Kerioth Hezron (also
called Hazor),
26 Amam, Shema, Moladah,
27 Hazar Gaddah, Heshmon, Beth Pelet,
28 Hazar Shual, Beersheba, Biziothiah,
29 Baalah, Iim, Ezem,
30 Eltolad, Chesil, Hormah,
31 Ziklag, Madmannah, Sansannah,
32 Lebaoth, Shilhim, Ain, and Rimmon.
All the cities are twenty-nine, with their
villages.
33 In the lowland, Eshtaol, Zorah, Ashnah,
34 Zanoah, En Gannim, Tappuah, Enam,
35 Jarmuth, Adullam, Socoh, Azekah,
36 Shaaraim, Adithaim and Gederah (or
Gederothaim); fourteen cities with their
villages.
37 Zenan, Hadashah, Migdal Gad,
38 Dilean, Mizpah, Joktheel,
39 Lachish, Bozkath, Eglon,
40 Cabbon, Lahmam, Chitlish,
41 Gederoth, Beth Dagon, Naamah, and
Makkedah; sixteen cities with their
villages.
42 Libnah, Ether, Ashan,
43 Iphtah, Ashnah, Nezib,
44 Keilah, Achzib, and Mareshah; nine
cities with their villages.
45 Ekron, with its towns and its villages;
46 from Ekron even to the sea, all that were
by the side of Ashdod, with their villages.
47 Ashdod, its towns and its villages; Gaza,
its towns and its villages; to the brook of
Egypt, and the great sea with its coastline.
48 In the hill country, Shamir, Jattir, Socoh,
49 Dannah, Kiriath Sannah (which is
Debir),
50 Anab, Eshtemoh, Anim,
51 Goshen, Holon, and Giloh; eleven cities
with their villages.
52 Arab, Dumah, Eshan,
53 Janim, Beth Tappuah, Aphekah,
54 Humtah, Kiriath Arba (also called
Hebron), and Zior; nine cities with their
villages.
55 Maon, Carmel, Ziph, Jutah,
56 Jezreel, Jokdeam, Zanoah,
57 Kain, Gibeah, and Timnah; ten cities
with their villages.
58 Halhul, Beth Zur, Gedor,
59 Maarath, Beth Anoth, and Eltekon; six
cities with their villages.
60 Kiriath Baal (also called Kiriath Jearim),
and Rabbah; two cities with their villages.
61 In the wilderness, Beth Arabah, Middin,
Secacah,
62 Nibshan, the City of Salt, and En Gedi;
six cities with their villages.
63 As for the Jebusites, the inhabitants of
Jerusalem, the children of Judah couldn’t
drive them out; but the Jebusites live with
the children of Judah at Jerusalem to this
day.

16

1 The lot came out for the children of
Joseph from the Jordan at Jericho, at the
waters of Jericho on the east, even the

wilderness, going up from Jericho
through the hill country to Bethel.
2 It went out from Bethel to Luz, and
passed along to the border of the Archites
to Ataroth;
3 and it went down westward to the
border of the Japhletites, to the border of
Beth Horon the lower, and on to Gezer;
and ended at the sea.
4 The children of Joseph, Manasseh and
Ephraim, took their inheritance.
5 This was the border of the children of
Ephraim according to their families. The
border of their inheritance eastward was
Ataroth Addar, to Beth Horon the upper.
6 The border went out westward at
Michmethath on the north. The border
turned about eastward to Taanath Shiloh,
and passed along it on the east of Janoah.
7 It went down from Janoah to Ataroth,
to Naarah, reached to Jericho, and went
out at the Jordan.
8 From Tappuah the border went along
westward to the brook of Kanah; and
ended at the sea. This is the inheritance of
the tribe of the children of Ephraim
according to their families;
9 together with the cities which were set
apart for the children of Ephraim in the
middle of the inheritance of the children
of Manasseh, all the cities with their
villages.
10 They didn't drive out the Canaanites
who lived in Gezer; but the Canaanites
dwell in the territory of Ephraim to this
day, and have become servants to do
forced labor.

17

1 This was the lot for the tribe of
Manasseh, for he was the firstborn of
Joseph. As for Machir the firstborn of
Manasseh, the father of Gilead, because
he was a man of war, therefore he had
Gilead and Bashan.
2 So this was for the rest of the children
of Manasseh according to their families:
for the children of Abiezer, for the
children of Helek, for the children of
Asriel, for the children of Shechem, for
the children of Hepher, and for the
children of Shemida. These were the male
children of Manasseh the son of Joseph
according to their families.
3 But Zelophehad, the son of Hepher, the
son of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of
Manasseh, had no sons, but daughters.
These are the names of his daughters:
Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and
Tirzah.
4 They came to Eleazar the priest, and to
Joshua the son of Nun, and to the princes,
saying, "Yahweh commanded Moses to
give us an inheritance among our
brothers." Therefore according to the
commandment of Yahweh he gave them
an inheritance among the brothers of
their father.
5 Ten parts fell to Manasseh, in addition
to the land of Gilead and Bashan, which is
beyond the Jordan;
6 because the daughters of Manasseh
had an inheritance among his sons. The
land of Gilead belonged to the rest of the
sons of Manasseh.
7 The border of Manasseh was from
Asher to Michmethath, which is before
Shechem. The border went along to the
right hand, to the inhabitants of En
Tappuah.
8 The land of Tappuah belonged to
Manasseh; but Tappuah on the border of
Manasseh belonged to the children of
Ephraim.
9 The border went down to the brook of
Kanah, southward of the brook. These
cities belonged to Ephraim among the
cities of Manasseh. The border of
Manasseh was on the north side of the
brook, and ended at the sea.
10 Southward it was Ephraim's, and
northward it was Manasseh's, and the sea
was his border. They reached to Asher on
the north, and to Issachar on the east.
11 Manasseh had three heights in
Issachar, in Asher Beth Shean and its
towns, and Ibleam and its towns, and the
inhabitants of Dor and its towns, and the
inhabitants of Endor and its towns, and
the inhabitants of Taanach and its towns,
and the inhabitants of Megiddo and its
towns.
12 Yet the children of Manasseh couldn't
drive out the inhabitants of those cities;
but the Canaanites would dwell in that
land.
13 When the children of Israel had

grown strong, they put the Canaanites to forced labor, and didn't utterly drive them out.
14 The children of Joseph spoke to Joshua, saying, "Why have you given me just one lot and one part for an inheritance, since we are a numerous people, because Yahweh has blessed us so far?"
15 Joshua said to them, "If you are a numerous people, go up to the forest, and clear land for yourself there in the land of the Perizzites and of the Rephaim, since the hill country of Ephraim is too narrow for you."
16 The children of Joseph said, "The hill country is not enough for us. All the Canaanites who dwell in the land of the valley have chariots of iron, both those who are in Beth Shean and its towns, and those who are in the valley of Jezreel."
17 Joshua spoke to the house of Joseph, that is, to Ephraim and to Manasseh, saying, "You are a numerous people, and have great power. You shall not have one lot only;
18 but the hill country shall be yours. Although it is a forest, you shall cut it down, and it's farthest extent shall be yours; for you shall drive out the Canaanites, though they have chariots of iron, and though they are strong."

18

1 The whole congregation of the children of Israel assembled themselves together at Shiloh, and set up the Tent of Meeting there. The land was subdued before them.
2 Seven tribes remained among the children of Israel, which had not yet divided their inheritance.
3 Joshua said to the children of Israel, "How long will you neglect to go in to possess the land, which Yahweh, the God of your fathers, has given you?
4 Appoint for yourselves three men from each tribe. I will send them, and they shall arise, walk through the land, and describe it according to their inheritance; then they shall come to me.
5 They shall divide it into seven portions. Judah shall live in his borders on the south, and the house of Joseph shall live in their borders on the north.
6 You shall survey the land into seven parts, and bring the description here to me; and I will cast lots for you here before Yahweh our God.
7 However, the Levites have no portion among you; for the priesthood of Yahweh is their inheritance. Gad, Reuben, and the half-tribe of Manasseh have received their inheritance east of the Jordan, which Moses the servant of Yahweh gave them."
8 The men arose and went. Joshua commanded those who went to survey the land, saying, "Go walk through the land, survey it, and come again to me. I will cast lots for you here before Yahweh in Shiloh."
9 The men went and passed through the land, and surveyed it by cities into seven portions in a book. They came to Joshua to the camp at Shiloh.
10 Joshua cast lots for them in Shiloh before Yahweh. There Joshua divided the land to the children of Israel according to their divisions.
11 The lot of the tribe of the children of Benjamin came up according to their families. The border of their lot went out between the children of Judah and the children of Joseph.
12 Their border on the north quarter was from the Jordan. The border went up to the side of Jericho on the north, and went up through the hill country westward. It ended at the wilderness of Beth Aven.
13 The border passed along from there to Luz, to the side of Luz (also called Bethel), southward. The border went down to Ataroth Addar, by the mountain that lies on the south of Beth Horon the lower.
14 The border extended, and turned around on the west quarter southward, from the mountain that lies before Beth Horon southward; and ended at Kiriath Baal (also called Kiriath Jearim), a city of the children of Judah. This was the west quarter.

15 The south quarter was from the
farthest part of Kiriath Jearim. The
border went out westward, and went out
to the spring of the waters of Nephtoah.
16 The border went down to the farthest
part of the mountain that lies before the
valley of the son of Hinnom, which is in
the valley of Rephaim northward. It went
down to the valley of Hinnom, to the side
of the Jebusite southward, and went down
to En Rogel.
17 It extended northward, went out at
En Shemesh, and went out to Geliloth,
which is opposite the ascent of Adummim.
It went down to the stone of Bohan the
son of Reuben.
18 It passed along to the side opposite
the Arabah northward, and went down to
the Arabah.
19 The border passed along to the side of
Beth Hoglah northward; and the border
ended at the north bay of the Salt Sea, at
the south end of the Jordan. This was the
south border.
20 The Jordan was its border on the east
quarter. This was the inheritance of the
children of Benjamin, by the borders
around it, according to their families.
21 Now the cities of the tribe of the
children of Benjamin according to their
families were Jericho, Beth Hoglah, Emek
Keziz,
22 Beth Arabah, Zemaraim, Bethel,
23 Avvim, Parah, Ophrah,
24 Chephar Ammoni, Ophni, and Geba;
twelve cities with their villages.
25 Gibeon, Ramah, Beeroth,
26 Mizpeh, Chephirah, Mozah,
27 Rekem, Irpeel, Taralah,
28 Zelah, Eleph, the Jebusite (also called
Jerusalem), Gibeath, and Kiriath; fourteen
cities with their villages. This is the
inheritance of the children of Benjamin
according to their families.

19

1 The second lot came out for Simeon,
even for the tribe of the children of
Simeon according to their families. Their
inheritance was in the middle of the
inheritance of the children of Judah.
2 They had for their inheritance
Beersheba (or Sheba), Moladah,
3 Hazar Shual, Balah, Ezem,
4 Eltolad, Bethul, Hormah,
5 Ziklag, Beth Marcaboth, Hazar Susah,
6 Beth Lebaoth, and Sharuhen; thirteen
cities with their villages;
7 Ain, Rimmon, Ether, and Ashan; four
cities with their villages;
8 and all the villages that were around
these cities to Baalath Beer, Ramah of the
South. This is the inheritance of the tribe
of the children of Simeon according to
their families.
9 Out of the part of the children of Judah
was the inheritance of the children of
Simeon; for the portion of the children of
Judah was too much for them. Therefore
the children of Simeon had inheritance in
the middle of their inheritance.
10 The third lot came up for the children
of Zebulun according to their families.
The border of their inheritance was to
Sarid.
11 Their border went up westward, even
to Maralah, and reached to Dabbesheth. It
reached to the brook that is before
Jokneam.
12 It turned from Sarid eastward toward
the sunrise to the border of Chisloth
Tabor. It went out to Daberath, and went
up to Japhia.
13 From there it passed along eastward
to Gath Hepher, to Ethkazin; and it went
out at Rimmon which stretches to Neah.
14 The border turned around it on the
north to Hannathon; and it ended at the
valley of Iphtah El;
15 Kattath, Nahalal, Shimron, Idalah,
and Bethlehem: twelve cities with their
villages.
16 This is the inheritance of the children
of Zebulun according to their families,
these cities with their villages.
17 The fourth lot came out for Issachar,
even for the children of Issachar
according to their families.
18 Their border was to Jezreel,
Chesulloth, Shunem,
19 Hapharaim, Shion, Anaharath,
20 Rabbith, Kishion, Ebez,
21 Remeth, Engannim, En Haddah, and
Beth Pazzez.

22 The border reached to Tabor,
Shahazumah, and Beth Shemesh. Their
border ended at the Jordan: sixteen cities
with their villages.
23 This is the inheritance of the tribe of
the children of Issachar according to their
families, the cities with their villages.
24 The fifth lot came out for the tribe of
the children of Asher according to their
families.
25 Their border was Helkath, Hali,
Beten, Achshaph,
26 Allammelech, Amad, Mishal. It
reached to Carmel westward, and to
Shihorlibnath.
27 It turned toward the sunrise to Beth
Dagon, and reached to Zebulun, and to the
valley of Iphtah El northward to Beth
Emek and Neiel. It went out to Cabul on
the left hand,
28 and Ebron, Rehob, Hammon, and
Kanah, even to great Sidon.
29 The border turned to Ramah, to the
fortified city of Tyre; and the border
turned to Hosah. It ended at the sea by the
region of Achzib;
30 Ummah also, and Aphek, and Rehob:
twenty-two cities with their villages.
31 This is the inheritance of the tribe of
the children of Asher according to their
families, these cities with their villages.
32 The sixth lot came out for the children
of Naphtali, even for the children of
Naphtali according to their families.
33 Their border was from Heleph, from
the oak in Zaanannim, Adami-nekeb, and
Jabneel, to Lakkum. It ended at the
Jordan.
34 The border turned westward to
Aznoth Tabor, and went out from there to
Hukkok. It reached to Zebulun on the
south, and reached to Asher on the west,
and to Judah at the Jordan toward the
sunrise.
35 The fortified cities were Ziddim, Zer,
Hammath, Rakkath, Chinnereth,
36 Adamah, Ramah, Hazor,
37 Kedesh, Edrei, En Hazor,
38 Iron, Migdal El, Horem, Beth Anath,
and Beth Shemesh; nineteen cities with
their villages.
39 This is the inheritance of the tribe of
the children of Naphtali according to their
families, the cities with their villages.
40 The seventh lot came out for the tribe
of the children of Dan according to their
families.
41 The border of their inheritance was
Zorah, Eshtaol, Irshemesh,
42 Shaalabbin, Aijalon, Ithlah,
43 Elon, Timnah, Ekron,
44 Eltekeh, Gibbethon, Baalath,
45 Jehud, Bene Berak, Gath Rimmon,
46 Me Jarkon, and Rakkon, with the
border opposite Joppa.
47 The border of the children of Dan
went out beyond them; for the children of
Dan went up and fought against Leshem,
and took it, and struck it with the edge of
the sword, and possessed it, and lived
therein, and called Leshem, Dan, after the
name of Dan their forefather.
48 This is the inheritance of the tribe of
the children of Dan according to their
families, these cities with their villages.
49 So they finished distributing the land
for inheritance by its borders. The
children of Israel gave an inheritance to
Joshua the son of Nun among them.
50 According to Yahweh's
commandment, they gave him the city
which he asked, even Timnathserah in the
hill country of Ephraim; and he built the
city, and lived there.
51 These are the inheritances, which
Eleazar the priest, Joshua the son of Nun,
and the heads of the fathers' houses of the
tribes of the children of Israel, distributed
for inheritance by lot in Shiloh before
Yahweh, at the door of the Tent of
Meeting. So they finished dividing the
land.

20

1 Yahweh spoke to Joshua, saying,
2 "Speak to the children of Israel, saying,
'Assign the cities of refuge, of which I
spoke to you by Moses,
3 that the man slayer who kills any
person accidentally or unintentionally
may flee there. They shall be to you for a
refuge from the avenger of blood.
4 He shall flee to one of those cities, and
shall stand at the entrance of the gate of
the city, and declare his case in the ears of

the elders of that city. They shall take him into the city with them, and give him a place, that he may live among them.
5 If the avenger of blood pursues him, then they shall not deliver up the man slayer into his hand; because he struck his neighbor unintentionally, and didn't hate him before.
6 He shall dwell in that city until he stands before the congregation for judgment, until the death of the high priest that shall be in those days. Then the man slayer shall return, and come to his own city, and to his own house, to the city he fled from.' "
7 They set apart Kedesh in Galilee in the hill country of Naphtali, Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim, and Kiriath Arba (also called Hebron) in the hill country of Judah.
8 Beyond the Jordan at Jericho eastward, they assigned Bezer in the wilderness in the plain out of the tribe of Reuben, Ramoth in Gilead out of the tribe of Gad, and Golan in Bashan out of the tribe of Manasseh.
9 These were the appointed cities for all the children of Israel, and for the alien who lives among them, that whoever kills any person unintentionally might flee there, and not die by the hand of the avenger of blood, until he stands trial before the congregation.

21

1 Then the heads of fathers' houses of the Levites came near to Eleazar the priest, and to Joshua the son of Nun, and to the heads of fathers' houses of the tribes of the children of Israel.
2 They spoke to them at Shiloh in the land of Canaan, saying, "Yahweh commanded through Moses to give us cities to dwell in, with their pasture lands for our livestock."
3 The children of Israel gave to the Levites out of their inheritance, according to the commandment of Yahweh, these cities with their pasture lands.
4 The lot came out for the families of the Kohathites. The children of Aaron the priest, who were of the Levites, had thirteen cities by lot out of the tribe of Judah, out of the tribe of the Simeonites, and out of the tribe of Benjamin.
5 The rest of the children of Kohath had ten cities by lot out of the families of the tribe of Ephraim, out of the tribe of Dan, and out of the half-tribe of Manasseh.
6 The children of Gershon had thirteen cities by lot out of the families of the tribe of Issachar, out of the tribe of Asher, out of the tribe of Naphtali, and out of the half-tribe of Manasseh in Bashan.
7 The children of Merari according to their families had twelve cities out of the tribe of Reuben, out of the tribe of Gad, and out of the tribe of Zebulun.
8 The children of Israel gave these cities with their pasture lands by lot to the Levites, as Yahweh commanded by Moses.
9 They gave out of the tribe of the children of Judah, and out of the tribe of the children of Simeon, these cities which are mentioned by name:
10 and they were for the children of Aaron, of the families of the Kohathites, who were of the children of Levi; for theirs was the first lot.
11 They gave them Kiriath Arba, named after the father of Anak (also called Hebron), in the hill country of Judah, with its pasture lands around it.
12 But they gave the fields of the city and its villages to Caleb the son of Jephunneh for his possession.
13 To the children of Aaron the priest they gave Hebron with its pasture lands, the city of refuge for the man slayer, Libnah with its pasture lands,
14 Jattir with its pasture lands, Eshtemoa with its pasture lands,
15 Holon with its pasture lands, Debir with its pasture lands,
16 Ain with its pasture lands, Juttah with its pasture lands, and Beth Shemesh with its pasture lands: nine cities out of those two tribes.
17 Out of the tribe of Benjamin, Gibeon with its pasture lands, Geba with its pasture lands,
18 Anathoth with its pasture lands, and Almon with its pasture lands: four cities.
19 All the cities of the children of Aaron,

the priests, were thirteen cities with their pasture lands.

20 The families of the children of Kohath, the Levites, even the rest of the children of Kohath, had the cities of their lot out of the tribe of Ephraim.
21 They gave them Shechem with its pasture lands in the hill country of Ephraim, the city of refuge for the man slayer, and Gezer with its pasture lands,
22 Kibzaim with its pasture lands, and Beth Horon with its pasture lands: four cities.
23 Out of the tribe of Dan, Elteke with its pasture lands, Gibbethon with its pasture lands,
24 Aijalon with its pasture lands, Gath Rimmon with its pasture lands: four cities.
25 Out of the half-tribe of Manasseh, Taanach with its pasture lands, and Gath Rimmon with its pasture lands: two cities.
26 All the cities of the families of the rest of the children of Kohath were ten with their pasture lands.

27 They gave to the children of Gershon, of the families of the Levites, out of the half-tribe of Manasseh Golan in Bashan with its pasture lands, the city of refuge for the man slayer, and Be Eshterah with its pasture lands: two cities.
28 Out of the tribe of Issachar, Kishion with its pasture lands, Daberath with its pasture lands,
29 Jarmuth with its pasture lands, En Gannim with its pasture lands: four cities.
30 Out of the tribe of Asher, Mishal with its pasture lands, Abdon with its pasture lands,
31 Helkath with its pasture lands, and Rehob with its pasture lands: four cities.
32 Out of the tribe of Naphtali, Kedesh in Galilee with its pasture lands, the city of refuge for the man slayer, Hammothdor with its pasture lands, and Kartan with its pasture lands: three cities.
33 All the cities of the Gershonites according to their families were thirteen cities with their pasture lands.

34 To the families of the children of Merari, the rest of the Levites, out of the tribe of Zebulun, Jokneam with its pasture lands, Kartah with its pasture lands,
35 Dimnah with its pasture lands, and Nahalal with its pasture lands: four cities.
36 Out of the tribe of Reuben, Bezer with its pasture lands, Jahaz with its pasture lands,
37 Kedemoth with its pasture lands, and Mephaath with its pasture lands: four cities.
38 Out of the tribe of Gad, Ramoth in Gilead with its pasture lands, the city of refuge for the man slayer, and Mahanaim with its pasture lands,
39 Heshbon with its pasture lands, Jazer with its pasture lands: four cities in all.
40 All these were the cities of the children of Merari according to their families, even the rest of the families of the Levites. Their lot was twelve cities.
41 All the cities of the Levites among the possessions of the children of Israel were forty-eight cities with their pasture lands.
42 Each of these cities included their pasture lands around them. It was this way with all these cities.
43 So Yahweh gave to Israel all the land which he swore to give to their fathers. They possessed it, and lived in it.
44 Yahweh gave them rest all around, according to all that he swore to their fathers. Not a man of all their enemies stood before them. Yahweh delivered all their enemies into their hand.
45 Nothing failed of any good thing which Yahweh had spoken to the house of Israel. All came to pass.

22

1 Then Joshua called the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh,
2 and said to them, “You have kept all that Moses the servant of Yahweh commanded you, and have listened to my voice in all that I commanded you.
3 You have not left your brothers these many days to this day, but have performed the duty of the commandment of Yahweh your God.
4 Now Yahweh your God has given rest to your brothers, as he spoke to them. Therefore now return and go to your

tents, to the land of your possession, which Moses the servant of Yahweh gave you beyond the Jordan.
5 Only take diligent heed to do the commandment and the law which Moses the servant of Yahweh commanded you, to love Yahweh your God, to walk in all his ways, to keep his commandments, to hold fast to him, and to serve him with all your heart and with all your soul."
6 So Joshua blessed them, and sent them away; and they went to their tents.
7 Now to the one half-tribe of Manasseh Moses had given inheritance in Bashan; but Joshua gave to the other half among their brothers beyond the Jordan westward. Moreover when Joshua sent them away to their tents, he blessed them,
8 and spoke to them, saying, "Return with much wealth to your tents, with very much livestock, with silver, with gold, with bronze, with iron, and with very much clothing. Divide the plunder of your enemies with your brothers."
9 The children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh returned, and departed from the children of Israel out of Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan, to go to the land of Gilead, to the land of their possession, which they owned, according to the commandment of Yahweh by Moses.
10 When they came to the region near the Jordan, that is in the land of Canaan, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh built an altar there by the Jordan, a great altar to look at.
11 The children of Israel heard this, "Behold, the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh have built an altar along the border of the land of Canaan, in the region around the Jordan, on the side that belongs to the children of Israel."
12 When the children of Israel heard of it, the whole congregation of the children of Israel gathered themselves together at Shiloh, to go up against them to war.
13 The children of Israel sent to the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh, into the land of Gilead, Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest.
14 With him were ten princes, one prince of a fathers' house for each of the tribes of Israel; and they were each head of their fathers' houses among the thousands of Israel.
15 They came to the children of Reuben, and to the children of Gad, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh, to the land of Gilead, and they spoke with them, saying,
16 "The whole congregation of Yahweh says, 'What trespass is this that you have committed against the God of Israel, to turn away today from following Yahweh, in that you have built yourselves an altar, to rebel today against Yahweh?
17 Is the iniquity of Peor too little for us, from which we have not cleansed ourselves to this day, although there came a plague on the congregation of Yahweh,
18 that you must turn away today from following Yahweh? It will be, since you rebel today against Yahweh, that tomorrow he will be angry with the whole congregation of Israel.
19 However, if the land of your possession is unclean, then pass over to the land of the possession of Yahweh, in which Yahweh's tabernacle dwells, and take possession among us; but don't rebel against Yahweh, nor rebel against us, in building an altar other than Yahweh our God's altar.
20 Didn't Achan the son of Zerah commit a trespass in the devoted thing, and wrath fell on all the congregation of Israel? That man didn't perish alone in his iniquity.' "
21 Then the children of Reuben and the children of Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh answered, and spoke to the heads of the thousands of Israel,
22 "The Mighty One, God, Yahweh, the Mighty One, God, Yahweh, he knows; and Israel shall know: if it was in rebellion, or if in trespass against Yahweh (don't save us today),
23 that we have built us an altar to turn away from following Yahweh; or if to offer burnt offering or meal offering, or if to offer sacrifices of peace offerings, let Yahweh himself require it.

24 "If we have not out of concern done
this, and for a reason, saying, 'In time to
come your children might speak to our
children, saying, "What have you to do
with Yahweh, the God of Israel?
25 For Yahweh has made the Jordan a
border between us and you, you children
of Reuben and children of Gad. You have
no portion in Yahweh." ' So your children
might make our children cease from
fearing Yahweh.
26 "Therefore we said, 'Let's now
prepare to build ourselves an altar, not
for burnt offering, nor for sacrifice;
27 but it will be a witness between us
and you, and between our generations
after us, that we may perform the service
of Yahweh before him with our burnt
offerings, with our sacrifices, and with
our peace offerings;' that your children
may not tell our children in time to come,
'You have no portion in Yahweh.'
28 "Therefore we said, 'It shall be, when
they tell us or our generations this in time
to come, that we shall say, "Behold the
pattern of Yahweh's altar, which our
fathers made, not for burnt offering, nor
for sacrifice; but it is a witness between us
and you." '
29 "Far be it from us that we should
rebel against Yahweh, and turn away
today from following Yahweh, to build an
altar for burnt offering, for meal offering,
or for sacrifice, besides Yahweh our God's
altar that is before his tabernacle!"
30 When Phinehas the priest, and the
princes of the congregation, even the
heads of the thousands of Israel that were
with him, heard the words that the
children of Reuben and the children of
Gad and the children of Manasseh spoke,
it pleased them well.
31 Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest
said to the children of Reuben, to the
children of Gad, and to the children of
Manasseh, "Today we know that Yahweh
is among us, because you have not
committed this trespass against Yahweh.
Now you have delivered the children of
Israel out of Yahweh's hand."
32 Phinehas the son of Eleazar the priest,
and the princes, returned from the
children of Reuben, and from the children
of Gad, out of the land of Gilead, to the
land of Canaan, to the children of Israel,
and brought them word again.
33 The thing pleased the children of
Israel; and the children of Israel blessed
God, and spoke no more of going up
against them to war, to destroy the land in
which the children of Reuben and the
children of Gad lived.
34 The children of Reuben and the
children of Gad named the altar "A
Witness Between Us that Yahweh is God."

23

1 After many days, when Yahweh had
given rest to Israel from their enemies all
around, and Joshua was old and well
advanced in years,
2 Joshua called for all Israel, for their
elders and for their heads, and for their
judges and for their officers, and said to
them, "I am old and well advanced in
years.
3 You have seen all that Yahweh your
God has done to all these nations because
of you; for it is Yahweh your God who has
fought for you.
4 Behold, I have allotted to you these
nations that remain, to be an inheritance
for your tribes, from the Jordan, with all
the nations that I have cut off, even to the
great sea toward the going down of the
sun.
5 Yahweh your God will thrust them out
from before you, and drive them from out
of your sight. You shall possess their land,
as Yahweh your God spoke to you.
6 "Therefore be very courageous to keep
and to do all that is written in the book of
the law of Moses, that you not turn away
from it to the right hand or to the left;
7 that you not come among these
nations, these that remain among you;
neither make mention of the name of
their gods, nor cause to swear by them,
neither serve them, nor bow down
yourselves to them;
8 but hold fast to Yahweh your God, as
you have done to this day.
9 "For Yahweh has driven great and
strong nations out from before you. But as

for you, no man has stood before you to this day.
10 One man of you shall chase a thousand; for it is Yahweh your God who fights for you, as he spoke to you.
11 Take good heed therefore to yourselves, that you love Yahweh your God.
12 "But if you do at all go back, and hold fast to the remnant of these nations, even these who remain among you, and make marriages with them, and go in to them, and they to you;
13 know for a certainty that Yahweh your God will no longer drive these nations from out of your sight; but they shall be a snare and a trap to you, a scourge in your sides, and thorns in your eyes, until you perish from off this good land which Yahweh your God has given you.
14 "Behold, today I am going the way of all the earth. You know in all your hearts and in all your souls that not one thing has failed of all the good things which Yahweh your God spoke concerning you. All have happened to you. Not one thing has failed of it.
15 It shall happen that as all the good things have come on you of which Yahweh your God spoke to you, so Yahweh will bring on you all the evil things, until he has destroyed you from off this good land which Yahweh your God has given you,
16 when you disobey the covenant of Yahweh your God, which he commanded you, and go and serve other gods, and bow down yourselves to them. Then Yahweh's anger will be kindled against you, and you will perish quickly from off the good land which he has given to you."

24

1 Joshua gathered all the tribes of Israel to Shechem, and called for the elders of Israel, for their heads, for their judges, and for their officers; and they presented themselves before God.
2 Joshua said to all the people, "Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, 'Your fathers lived of old time beyond the River, even Terah, the father of Abraham, and the father of Nahor. They served other gods.
3 I took your father Abraham from beyond the River, and led him throughout all the land of Canaan, and multiplied his offspring,† and gave him Isaac.
4 I gave to Isaac Jacob and Esau: and I gave to Esau Mount Seir, to possess it. Jacob and his children went down into Egypt.
5 " 'I sent Moses and Aaron, and I plagued Egypt, according to that which I did among them: and afterward I brought you out.
6 I brought your fathers out of Egypt: and you came to the sea. The Egyptians pursued your fathers with chariots and with horsemen to the Red Sea.
7 When they cried out to Yahweh, he put darkness between you and the Egyptians, and brought the sea on them, and covered them; and your eyes saw what I did in Egypt. You lived in the wilderness many days.
8 " 'I brought you into the land of the Amorites, that lived beyond the Jordan. They fought with you, and I gave them into your hand. You possessed their land, and I destroyed them from before you.
9 Then Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab, arose and fought against Israel. He sent and called Balaam the son of Beor to curse you,
10 but I would not listen to Balaam; therefore he blessed you still. So I delivered you out of his hand.
11 " 'You went over the Jordan, and came to Jericho. The men of Jericho fought against you, the Amorite, the Perizzite, the Canaanite, the Hittite, the Girgashite, the Hivite, and the Jebusite; and I delivered them into your hand.
12 I sent the hornet before you, which drove them out from before you, even the two kings of the Amorites; not with your sword, nor with your bow.
13 I gave you a land on which you had not labored, and cities which you didn't build, and you live in them. You eat of

† **24:3** or, seed

vineyards and olive groves which you
didn't plant.'
14 "Now therefore fear Yahweh, and
serve him in sincerity and in truth. Put
away the gods which your fathers served
beyond the River, in Egypt; and serve
Yahweh.
15 If it seems evil to you to serve
Yahweh, choose today whom you will
serve; whether the gods which your
fathers served that were beyond the
River, or the gods of the Amorites, in
whose land you dwell; but as for me and
my house, we will serve Yahweh."
16 The people answered, "Far be it from
us that we should forsake Yahweh, to
serve other gods;
17 for it is Yahweh our God who brought
us and our fathers up out of the land of
Egypt, from the house of bondage, and
who did those great signs in our sight, and
preserved us in all the way in which we
went, and among all the peoples through
the middle of whom we passed.
18 Yahweh drove out from before us all
the peoples, even the Amorites who lived
in the land. Therefore we also will serve
Yahweh; for he is our God."
19 Joshua said to the people, "You can't
serve Yahweh, for he is a holy God. He is a
jealous God. He will not forgive your
disobedience nor your sins.
20 If you forsake Yahweh, and serve
foreign gods, then he will turn and do you
evil, and consume you, after he has done
you good."
21 The people said to Joshua, "No, but we
will serve Yahweh."
22 Joshua said to the people, "You are
witnesses against yourselves that you
have chosen Yahweh yourselves, to serve
him."
They said, "We are witnesses."
23 "Now therefore put away the foreign
gods which are among you, and incline
your heart to Yahweh, the God of Israel."
24 The people said to Joshua, "We will
serve Yahweh our God, and we will listen
to his voice."
25 So Joshua made a covenant with the
people that day, and made for them a
statute and an ordinance in Shechem.
26 Joshua wrote these words in the book
of the law of God; and he took a great
stone, and set it up there under the oak
that was by the sanctuary of Yahweh.
27 Joshua said to all the people, "Behold,
this stone shall be a witness against us, for
it has heard all Yahweh's words which he
spoke to us. It shall be therefore a witness
against you, lest you deny your God."
28 So Joshua sent the people away, each
to his own inheritance.
29 After these things, Joshua the son of
Nun, the servant of Yahweh, died, being
one hundred ten years old.
30 They buried him in the border of his
inheritance in Timnathserah, which is in
the hill country of Ephraim, on the north
of the mountain of Gaash.
31 Israel served Yahweh all the days of
Joshua, and all the days of the elders who
outlived Joshua, and had known all the
work of Yahweh, that he had worked for
Israel.
32 They buried the bones of Joseph,
which the children of Israel brought up
out of Egypt, in Shechem, in the parcel of
ground which Jacob bought from the sons
of Hamor the father of Shechem for a
hundred pieces of silver.‡ They became
the inheritance of the children of Joseph.
33 Eleazar the son of Aaron died. They
buried him in the hill of Phinehas his son,
which was given him in the hill country of
Ephraim.

‡ **24:32** Hebrew: kesitahs. A kesitah was a kind of silver coin.

The Book of Judges

1 After the death of Joshua, the children
of Israel asked of Yahweh,† saying, "Who
should go up for us first against the
Canaanites, to fight against them?"
2 Yahweh said, "Judah shall go up.
Behold,‡ I have delivered the land into his
hand."
3 Judah said to Simeon his brother,
"Come up with me into my lot, that we
may fight against the Canaanites; and I
likewise will go with you into your lot." So
Simeon went with him.
4 Judah went up, and Yahweh delivered
the Canaanites and the Perizzites into
their hand. They struck ten thousand men
in Bezek.
5 They found Adoni-Bezek in Bezek, and
they fought against him. They struck the
Canaanites and the Perizzites.
6 But Adoni-Bezek fled. They pursued
him, caught him, and cut off his thumbs
and his big toes.
7 Adoni-Bezek said, "Seventy kings,
having their thumbs and their big toes cut
off, scavenged under my table. As I have
done, so God§ has done to me." They
brought him to Jerusalem, and he died
there.
8 The children of Judah fought against
Jerusalem, took it, struck it with the edge
of the sword, and set the city on fire.
9 After that, the children of Judah went
down to fight against the Canaanites who
lived in the hill country, and in the South,
and in the lowland.
10 Judah went against the Canaanites
who lived in Hebron. (The name of
Hebron before that was Kiriath Arba.)
They struck Sheshai, Ahiman, and Talmai.
11 From there he went against the
inhabitants of Debir. (The name of Debir
before that was Kiriath Sepher.)
12 Caleb said, "I will give Achsah my
daughter as wife to the man who strikes
Kiriath Sepher, and takes it."
13 Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb's
younger brother, took it, so he gave him
Achsah his daughter as his wife.
14 When she came, she got him to ask
her father for a field. She got off her
donkey; and Caleb said to her, "What
would you like?"
15 She said to him, "Give me a blessing;
because you have set me in the land of the
South, give me also springs of water."
Then Caleb gave her the upper springs
and the lower springs.
16 The children of the Kenite, Moses'
brother-in-law, went up out of the city of
palm trees with the children of Judah into
the wilderness of Judah, which is in the
south of Arad; and they went and lived
with the people.
17 Judah went with Simeon his brother,
and they struck the Canaanites who
inhabited Zephath, and utterly destroyed
it. The name of the city was called
Hormah.
18 Also Judah took Gaza with its border,
and Ashkelon with its border, and Ekron
with its border.
19 Yahweh was with Judah, and drove
out the inhabitants of the hill country; for
he could not drive out the inhabitants of
the valley, because they had chariots of
iron.
20 They gave Hebron to Caleb, as Moses
had said, and he drove the three sons of
Anak out of there.
21 The children of Benjamin didn't drive
out the Jebusites who inhabited
Jerusalem, but the Jebusites dwell with
the children of Benjamin in Jerusalem to
this day.
22 The house of Joseph also went up
against Bethel, and Yahweh was with
them.
23 The house of Joseph sent to spy out
Bethel. (The name of the city before that
was Luz.)

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:2** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. § **1:7** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

24 The watchers saw a man come out of
the city, and they said to him, “Please
show us the entrance into the city, and we
will deal kindly with you.”
25 He showed them the entrance into the
city, and they struck the city with the edge
of the sword; but they let the man and all
his family go.
26 The man went into the land of the
Hittites, built a city, and called its name
Luz, which is its name to this day.
27 Manasseh didn’t drive out the
inhabitants of Beth Shean and its towns,
nor Taanach and its towns, nor the
inhabitants of Dor and its towns, nor the
inhabitants of Ibleam and its towns, nor
the inhabitants of Megiddo and its towns;
but the Canaanites would dwell in that
land.
28 When Israel had grown strong, they
put the Canaanites to forced labor, and
didn’t utterly drive them out.
29 Ephraim didn’t drive out the
Canaanites who lived in Gezer, but the
Canaanites lived in Gezer among them.
30 Zebulun didn’t drive out the
inhabitants of Kitron, nor the inhabitants
of Nahalol; but the Canaanites lived
among them, and became subject to
forced labor.
31 Asher didn’t drive out the inhabitants
of Acco, nor the inhabitants of Sidon, nor
of Ahlab, nor of Achzib, nor of Helbah,
nor of Aphik, nor of Rehob;
32 but the Asherites lived among the
Canaanites, the inhabitants of the land,
for they didn’t drive them out.
33 Naphtali didn’t drive out the
inhabitants of Beth Shemesh, nor the
inhabitants of Beth Anath; but he lived
among the Canaanites, the inhabitants of
the land. Nevertheless the inhabitants of
Beth Shemesh and of Beth Anath became
subject to forced labor.
34 The Amorites forced the children of
Dan into the hill country, for they would
not allow them to come down to the
valley;
35 but the Amorites would dwell in
Mount Heres, in Aijalon, and in Shaalbim.
Yet the hand of the house of Joseph
prevailed, so that they became subject to
forced labor.
36 The border of the Amorites was from
the ascent of Akrabbim, from the rock,
and upward.

2

1 Yahweh’s angel came up from Gilgal to
Bochim. He said, “I brought you out of
Egypt, and have brought you to the land
which I swore to give your fathers. I said,
‘I will never break my covenant with you.
2 You shall make no covenant with the
inhabitants of this land. You shall break
down their altars.’ But you have not
listened to my voice. Why have you done
this?
3 Therefore I also said, ‘I will not drive
them out from before you; but they shall
be in your sides, and their gods will be a
snare to you.’ ”
4 When Yahweh’s angel spoke these
words to all the children of Israel, the
people lifted up their voice and wept.
5 They called the name of that place
Bochim,† and they sacrificed there to
Yahweh.
6 Now when Joshua had sent the people
away, the children of Israel each went to
his inheritance to possess the land.
7 The people served Yahweh all the days
of Joshua, and all the days of the elders
who outlived Joshua, who had seen all the
great work of Yahweh that he had worked
for Israel.
8 Joshua the son of Nun, the servant of
Yahweh, died, being one hundred ten
years old.
9 They buried him in the border of his
inheritance in Timnath Heres, in the hill
country of Ephraim, on the north of the
mountain of Gaash.
10 After all that generation were
gathered to their fathers, another
generation arose after them who didn’t
know Yahweh, nor the work which he had
done for Israel.
11 The children of Israel did that which
was evil in Yahweh’s sight, and served the
Baals.
12 They abandoned Yahweh, the God of
their fathers, who brought them out of the
land of Egypt, and followed other gods, of

† **2:5** “Bochim” means “weepers”.

the gods of the peoples who were around them, and bowed themselves down to them; and they provoked Yahweh to anger.
13 They abandoned Yahweh, and served Baal and the Ashtaroth.
14 Yahweh's anger burned against Israel, and he delivered them into the hands of raiders who plundered them. He sold them into the hands of their enemies all around, so that they could no longer stand before their enemies.
15 Wherever they went out, Yahweh's hand was against them for evil, as Yahweh had spoken, and as Yahweh had sworn to them; and they were very distressed.
16 Yahweh raised up judges, who saved them out of the hand of those who plundered them.
17 Yet they didn't listen to their judges; for they prostituted themselves to other gods, and bowed themselves down to them. They quickly turned away from the way in which their fathers walked, obeying Yahweh's commandments. They didn't do so.
18 When Yahweh raised up judges for them, then Yahweh was with the judge, and saved them out of the hand of their enemies all the days of the judge; for it grieved Yahweh because of their groaning by reason of those who oppressed them and troubled them.
19 But when the judge was dead, they turned back, and dealt more corruptly than their fathers in following other gods to serve them and to bow down to them. They didn't cease what they were doing, or give up their stubborn ways.
20 Yahweh's anger burned against Israel; and he said, "Because this nation transgressed my covenant which I commanded their fathers, and has not listened to my voice,
21 I also will no longer drive out any of the nations that Joshua left when he died from before them;
22 that by them I may test Israel, to see if they will keep Yahweh's way to walk therein, as their fathers kept it, or not."
23 So Yahweh left those nations, without driving them out hastily. He didn't deliver them into Joshua's hand.

3

1 Now these are the nations which Yahweh left, to test Israel by them, even as many as had not known all the wars of Canaan;
2 only that the generations of the children of Israel might know, to teach them war, at least those who knew nothing of it before:
3 the five lords of the Philistines, all the Canaanites, the Sidonians, and the Hivites who lived on Mount Lebanon, from Mount Baal Hermon to the entrance of Hamath.
4 They were left to test Israel by them, to know whether they would listen to Yahweh's commandments, which he commanded their fathers by Moses.
5 The children of Israel lived among the Canaanites, the Hittites, the Amorites, the Perizzites, the Hivites, and the Jebusites.
6 They took their daughters to be their wives, and gave their own daughters to their sons and served their gods.
7 The children of Israel did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, and forgot Yahweh their God, and served the Baals and the Asheroth.
8 Therefore Yahweh's anger burned against Israel, and he sold them into the hand of Cushan Rishathaim king of Mesopotamia; and the children of Israel served Cushan Rishathaim eight years.
9 When the children of Israel cried to Yahweh, Yahweh raised up a savior to the children of Israel, who saved them, even Othniel the son of Kenaz, Caleb's younger brother.
10 Yahweh's Spirit came on him, and he judged Israel; and he went out to war, and Yahweh delivered Cushan Rishathaim king of Mesopotamia into his hand. His hand prevailed against Cushan Rishathaim.
11 The land had rest forty years, then Othniel the son of Kenaz died.
12 The children of Israel again did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, and Yahweh strengthened Eglon the king of Moab against Israel, because they had

done that which was evil in Yahweh's sight.
13 He gathered the children of Ammon and Amalek to himself; and he went and struck Israel, and they possessed the city of palm trees.
14 The children of Israel served Eglon the king of Moab eighteen years.
15 But when the children of Israel cried to Yahweh, Yahweh raised up a savior for them: Ehud the son of Gera, the Benjamite, a left-handed man. The children of Israel sent tribute by him to Eglon the king of Moab.
16 Ehud made himself a sword which had two edges, a cubit† in length; and he wore it under his clothing on his right thigh.
17 He offered the tribute to Eglon king of Moab. Now Eglon was a very fat man.
18 When Ehud had finished offering the tribute, he sent away the people who carried the tribute.
19 But he himself turned back from the stone idols that were by Gilgal, and said, "I have a secret message for you, O king."

The king said, "Keep silence!" All who stood by him left him.

20 Ehud came to him; and he was sitting by himself alone in the cool upper room. Ehud said, "I have a message from God to you." He arose out of his seat.
21 Ehud put out his left hand, and took the sword from his right thigh, and thrust it into his body.
22 The handle also went in after the blade; and the fat closed on the blade, for he didn't draw the sword out of his body; and it came out behind.
23 Then Ehud went out onto the porch, and shut the doors of the upper room on him, and locked them.
24 After he had gone, his servants came and saw that the doors of the upper room were locked. They said, "Surely he is covering his feet‡ in the upper room."
25 They waited until they were ashamed; and behold, he didn't open the doors of the upper room. Therefore they took the key and opened them, and behold, their lord had fallen down dead on the floor.
26 Ehud escaped while they waited, passed beyond the stone idols, and escaped to Seirah.
27 When he had come, he blew a trumpet in the hill country of Ephraim; and the children of Israel went down with him from the hill country, and he led them.
28 He said to them, "Follow me; for Yahweh has delivered your enemies the Moabites into your hand." They followed him, and took the fords of the Jordan against the Moabites, and didn't allow any man to pass over.
29 They struck at that time about ten thousand men of Moab, every strong man and every man of valor. No man escaped.
30 So Moab was subdued that day under the hand of Israel. Then the land had rest eighty years.
31 After him was Shamgar the son of Anath, who struck six hundred men of the Philistines with an ox goad. He also saved Israel.

4

1 The children of Israel again did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, when Ehud was dead.
2 Yahweh sold them into the hand of Jabin king of Canaan, who reigned in Hazor; the captain of whose army was Sisera, who lived in Harosheth of the Gentiles.
3 The children of Israel cried to Yahweh, for he had nine hundred chariots of iron; and he mightily oppressed the children of Israel for twenty years.
4 Now Deborah, a prophetess, the wife of Lappidoth, judged Israel at that time.
5 She lived under Deborah's palm tree between Ramah and Bethel in the hill country of Ephraim; and the children of Israel came up to her for judgment.
6 She sent and called Barak the son of Abinoam out of Kedesh Naphtali, and said to him, "Hasn't Yahweh, the God of Israel, commanded, 'Go and lead the way to

† **3:16** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. ‡ **3:24** or, "relieving himself".

Mount Tabor, and take with you ten
thousand men of the children of Naphtali
and of the children of Zebulun?
7 I will draw to you, to the river Kishon,
Sisera, the captain of Jabin's army, with
his chariots and his multitude; and I will
deliver him into your hand.' "
8 Barak said to her, "If you will go with
me, then I will go; but if you will not go
with me, I will not go."
9 She said, "I will surely go with you.
Nevertheless, the journey that you take
won't be for your honor; for Yahweh will
sell Sisera into a woman's hand." Deborah
arose, and went with Barak to Kedesh.
10 Barak called Zebulun and Naphtali
together to Kedesh. Ten thousand men
followed him; and Deborah went up with
him.
11 Now Heber the Kenite had separated
himself from the Kenites, even from the
children of Hobab, Moses' brother-in-law,
and had pitched his tent as far as the oak
in Zaanannim, which is by Kedesh.
12 They told Sisera that Barak the son of
Abinoam had gone up to Mount Tabor.
13 Sisera gathered together all his
chariots, even nine hundred chariots of
iron, and all the people who were with
him, from Harosheth of the Gentiles, to
the river Kishon.
14 Deborah said to Barak, "Go; for this is
the day in which Yahweh has delivered
Sisera into your hand. Hasn't Yahweh
gone out before you?" So Barak went
down from Mount Tabor, and ten
thousand men after him.
15 Yahweh confused Sisera, all his
chariots, and all his army, with the edge of
the sword before Barak. Sisera
abandoned his chariot and fled away on
his feet.
16 But Barak pursued the chariots and
the army to Harosheth of the Gentiles;
and all the army of Sisera fell by the edge
of the sword. There was not a man left.
17 However Sisera fled away on his feet
to the tent of Jael the wife of Heber the
Kenite; for there was peace between Jabin
the king of Hazor and the house of Heber
the Kenite.
18 Jael went out to meet Sisera, and said
to him, "Turn in, my lord, turn in to me;
don't be afraid." He came in to her into
the tent, and she covered him with a rug.
19 He said to her, "Please give me a little
water to drink; for I am thirsty."
She opened a container of milk, and
gave him a drink, and covered him.
20 He said to her, "Stand in the door of
the tent, and if any man comes and
inquires of you, and says, 'Is there any
man here?' you shall say, 'No.' "
21 Then Jael, Heber's wife, took a tent
peg, and took a hammer in her hand, and
went softly to him, and struck the pin into
his temples, and it pierced through into
the ground, for he was in a deep sleep; so
he fainted and died.
22 Behold, as Barak pursued Sisera, Jael
came out to meet him, and said to him,
"Come, and I will show you the man
whom you seek." He came to her; and
behold, Sisera lay dead, and the tent peg
was in his temples.
23 So God subdued Jabin the king of
Canaan before the children of Israel on
that day.
24 The hand of the children of Israel
prevailed more and more against Jabin
the king of Canaan, until they had
destroyed Jabin king of Canaan.

5

1 Then Deborah and Barak the son of
Abinoam sang on that day, saying,
2 "Because the leaders took the lead in
Israel,
because the people offered
themselves willingly,
be blessed, Yahweh!

3 "Hear, you kings!
Give ear, you princes!
I, even I, will sing to Yahweh.
I will sing praise to Yahweh, the God
of Israel.

4 "Yahweh, when you went out of Seir,
when you marched out of the field of
Edom,
the earth trembled, the sky also dropped.
Yes, the clouds dropped water.

5 The mountains quaked at Yahweh's
presence,
even Sinai at the presence of Yahweh,
the God of Israel.

6 "In the days of Shamgar the son of Anath,
in the days of Jael, the highways were
unoccupied.
The travelers walked through
byways.
7 The rulers ceased in Israel.
They ceased until I, Deborah, arose;
Until I arose a mother in Israel.
8 They chose new gods.
Then war was in the gates.
Was there a shield or spear seen
among forty thousand in Israel?
9 My heart is toward the governors of
Israel,
who offered themselves willingly
among the people.
Bless Yahweh!

10 "Speak, you who ride on white donkeys,
you who sit on rich carpets,
and you who walk by the way.
11 Far from the noise of archers, in the
places of drawing water,
there they will rehearse Yahweh's
righteous acts,
the righteous acts of his rule in Israel.

"Then Yahweh's people went down to the
gates.
12 'Awake, awake, Deborah!
Awake, awake, utter a song!
Arise, Barak, and lead away your
captives, you son of Abinoam.'

13 "Then a remnant of the nobles and the
people came down.
Yahweh came down for me against
the mighty.
14 Those whose root is in Amalek came out
of Ephraim,
after you, Benjamin, among your
peoples.
Governors come down out of Machir.
Those who handle the marshal's staff
came out of Zebulun.
15 The princes of Issachar were with
Deborah.
As was Issachar, so was Barak.
They rushed into the valley at his feet.
By the watercourses of Reuben,
there were great resolves of heart.
16 Why did you sit among the sheepfolds?
To hear the whistling for the flocks?
At the watercourses of Reuben,
there were great searchings of heart.
17 Gilead lived beyond the Jordan.
Why did Dan remain in ships?
Asher sat still at the haven of the sea,
and lived by his creeks.
18 Zebulun was a people that jeopardized
their lives to the death;
Naphtali also, on the high places of
the field.

19 "The kings came and fought,
then the kings of Canaan fought at
Taanach by the waters of Megiddo.
They took no plunder of silver.
20 From the sky the stars fought.
From their courses, they fought
against Sisera.
21 The river Kishon swept them away,
that ancient river, the river Kishon.
My soul, march on with strength.
22 Then the horse hoofs stamped because
of the prancing,
the prancing of their strong ones.
23 'Curse Meroz,' said Yahweh's angel.
'Curse bitterly its inhabitants,
because they didn't come to help
Yahweh,
to help Yahweh against the mighty.'

24 "Jael shall be blessed above women,
the wife of Heber the Kenite;
blessed shall she be above women in
the tent.
25 He asked for water.
She gave him milk.
She brought him butter in a lordly
dish.
26 She put her hand to the tent peg,
and her right hand to the workmen's
hammer.
With the hammer she struck Sisera.
She struck through his head.
Yes, she pierced and struck through
his temples.
27 At her feet he bowed, he fell, he lay.
At her feet he bowed, he fell.

Where he bowed, there he fell down
dead.

28 “Through the window she looked out,
and cried:
Sisera’s mother looked through the
lattice.
‘Why is his chariot so long in coming?
Why do the wheels of his chariots
wait?’
29 Her wise ladies answered her,
Yes, she returned answer to herself,
30 ‘Have they not found, have they not
divided the plunder?
A lady, two ladies to every man;
to Sisera a plunder of dyed garments,
a plunder of dyed garments
embroidered,
of dyed garments embroidered on
both sides, on the necks of the
plunder?’

31 “So let all your enemies perish, Yahweh,
but let those who love him be as the
sun when it rises in its strength.”

Then the land had rest forty years.

6

1 The children of Israel did that which
was evil in Yahweh’s sight, so Yahweh
delivered them into the hand of Midian
seven years.
2 The hand of Midian prevailed against
Israel; and because of Midian the children
of Israel made themselves the dens which
are in the mountains, the caves, and the
strongholds.
3 So it was, when Israel had sown, that
the Midianites, the Amalekites, and the
children of the east came up against them.
4 They encamped against them, and
destroyed the increase of the earth, until
you come to Gaza. They left no sustenance
in Israel, and no sheep, ox, or donkey.
5 For they came up with their livestock
and their tents. They came in as locusts
for multitude. Both they and their camels
were without number; and they came into
the land to destroy it.
6 Israel was brought very low because of
Midian; and the children of Israel cried to
Yahweh.
7 When the children of Israel cried to
Yahweh because of Midian,
8 Yahweh sent a prophet to the children
of Israel; and he said to them, “Yahweh,
the God of Israel, says, ‘I brought you up
from Egypt, and brought you out of the
house of bondage.
9 I delivered you out of the hand of the
Egyptians and out of the hand of all who
oppressed you, and drove them out from
before you, and gave you their land.
10 I said to you, “I am Yahweh your God.
You shall not fear the gods of the
Amorites, in whose land you dwell.” But
you have not listened to my voice.’ ”
11 Yahweh’s angel came and sat under
the oak which was in Ophrah, that
belonged to Joash the Abiezrite. His son
Gideon was beating out wheat in the wine
press, to hide it from the Midianites.
12 Yahweh’s angel appeared to him, and
said to him, “Yahweh is with you, you
mighty man of valor!”
13 Gideon said to him, “Oh, my lord, if
Yahweh is with us, why then has all this
happened to us? Where are all his
wondrous works which our fathers told
us of, saying, ‘Didn’t Yahweh bring us up
from Egypt?’ But now Yahweh has cast us
off, and delivered us into the hand of
Midian.”
14 Yahweh looked at him, and said, “Go
in this your might, and save Israel from
the hand of Midian. Haven’t I sent you?”
15 He said to him, “O Lord,† how shall I
save Israel? Behold, my family is the
poorest in Manasseh, and I am the least in
my father’s house.”
16 Yahweh said to him, “Surely I will be
with you, and you shall strike the
Midianites as one man.”
17 He said to him, “If now I have found
favor in your sight, then show me a sign
that it is you who talk with me.
18 Please don’t go away until I come to
you, and bring out my present, and lay it
before you.”

† **6:15** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai.” ‡ **6:19** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

He said, “I will wait until you come
back.”
19 Gideon went in and prepared a young
goat and unleavened cakes of an ephah‡
of meal. He put the meat in a basket and
he put the broth in a pot, and brought it
out to him under the oak, and presented it.
20 The angel of God said to him, “Take
the meat and the unleavened cakes, and
lay them on this rock, and pour out the
broth.”
He did so.
21 Then Yahweh’s angel stretched out
the end of the staff that was in his hand,
and touched the meat and the unleavened
cakes; and fire went up out of the rock
and consumed the meat and the
unleavened cakes. Then Yahweh’s angel
departed out of his sight.
22 Gideon saw that he was Yahweh’s
angel; and Gideon said, “Alas, Lord
Yahweh! Because I have seen Yahweh’s
angel face to face!”
23 Yahweh said to him, “Peace be to you!
Don’t be afraid. You shall not die.”
24 Then Gideon built an altar there to
Yahweh, and called it “Yahweh is Peace.”§
To this day it is still in Ophrah of the
Abiezrites.
25 That same night, Yahweh said to him,
“Take your father’s bull, even the second
bull seven years old, and throw down the
altar of Baal that your father has, and cut
down the Asherah that is by it.
26 Then build an altar to Yahweh your
God on the top of this stronghold, in an
orderly way, and take the second bull, and
offer a burnt offering with the wood of
the Asherah which you shall cut down.”
27 Then Gideon took ten men of his
servants, and did as Yahweh had spoken
to him. Because he feared his father’s
household and the men of the city, he
could not do it by day, but he did it by
night.
28 When the men of the city arose early
in the morning, behold, the altar of Baal
was broken down, and the Asherah was
cut down that was by it, and the second
bull was offered on the altar that was
built.
29 They said to one another, “Who has
done this thing?”
When they inquired and asked, they
said, “Gideon the son of Joash has done
this thing.”
30 Then the men of the city said to Joash,
“Bring out your son, that he may die,
because he has broken down the altar of
Baal, and because he has cut down the
Asherah that was by it.”
31 Joash said to all who stood against
him, “Will you contend for Baal? Or will
you save him? He who will contend for
him, let him be put to death by morning!
If he is a god, let him contend for himself,
because someone has broken down his
altar!”
32 Therefore on that day he named him
Jerub-Baal,† saying, “Let Baal contend
against him, because he has broken down
his altar.”
33 Then all the Midianites and the
Amalekites and the children of the east
assembled themselves together; and they
passed over, and encamped in the valley
of Jezreel.
34 But Yahweh’s Spirit came on Gideon,
and he blew a trumpet; and Abiezer was
gathered together to follow him.
35 He sent messengers throughout all
Manasseh, and they also were gathered
together to follow him. He sent
messengers to Asher, to Zebulun, and to
Naphtali; and they came up to meet them.
36 Gideon said to God, “If you will save
Israel by my hand, as you have spoken,
37 behold, I will put a fleece of wool on
the threshing floor. If there is dew on the
fleece only, and it is dry on all the ground,
then I’ll know that you will save Israel by
my hand, as you have spoken.”
38 It was so; for he rose up early on the
next day, and pressed the fleece together,
and wrung the dew out of the fleece, a
bowl full of water.
39 Gideon said to God, “Don’t let your
anger be kindled against me, and I will
speak but this once. Please let me make a
trial just this once with the fleece. Let it

§ **6:24** or, Yahweh Shalom † **6:32** “Jerub-Baal” means “Let Baal contend”.

now be dry only on the fleece, and on all the ground let there be dew."
40 God did so that night; for it was dry on the fleece only, and there was dew on all the ground.

7

1 Then Jerubbaal, who is Gideon, and all the people who were with him, rose up early and encamped beside the spring of Harod. Midian's camp was on the north side of them, by the hill of Moreh, in the valley.
2 Yahweh said to Gideon, "The people who are with you are too many for me to give the Midianites into their hand, lest Israel brag against me, saying, 'My own hand has saved me.'
3 Now therefore proclaim in the ears of the people, saying, 'Whoever is fearful and trembling, let him return and depart from Mount Gilead.' " So twenty-two thousand of the people returned, and ten thousand remained.
4 Yahweh said to Gideon, "There are still too many people. Bring them down to the water, and I will test them for you there. It shall be, that those whom I tell you, 'This shall go with you,' shall go with you; and whoever I tell you, 'This shall not go with you,' shall not go."
5 So he brought down the people to the water; and Yahweh said to Gideon, "Everyone who laps of the water with his tongue, like a dog laps, you shall set him by himself; likewise everyone who bows down on his knees to drink."
6 The number of those who lapped, putting their hand to their mouth, was three hundred men; but all the rest of the people bowed down on their knees to drink water.
7 Yahweh said to Gideon, "I will save you by the three hundred men who lapped, and deliver the Midianites into your hand. Let all the other people go, each to his own place."
8 So the people took food in their hand, and their trumpets; and he sent all the rest of the men of Israel to their own tents, but retained the three hundred men; and the camp of Midian was beneath him in the valley.
9 That same night, Yahweh said to him, "Arise, go down into the camp, for I have delivered it into your hand.
10 But if you are afraid to go down, go with Purah your servant down to the camp.
11 You will hear what they say; and afterward your hands will be strengthened to go down into the camp." Then went he down with Purah his servant to the outermost part of the armed men who were in the camp.
12 The Midianites and the Amalekites and all the children of the east lay along in the valley like locusts for multitude; and their camels were without number, as the sand which is on the seashore for multitude.
13 When Gideon had come, behold, there was a man telling a dream to his fellow. He said, "Behold, I dreamed a dream; and behold, a cake of barley bread tumbled into the camp of Midian, came to the tent, and struck it so that it fell, and turned it upside down, so that the tent lay flat."
14 His fellow answered, "This is nothing other than the sword of Gideon the son of Joash, a man of Israel. God has delivered Midian into his hand, with all the army."
15 It was so, when Gideon heard the telling of the dream and its interpretation, that he worshiped. Then he returned into the camp of Israel and said, "Arise, for Yahweh has delivered the army of Midian into your hand!"
16 He divided the three hundred men into three companies, and he put into the hands of all of them trumpets and empty pitchers, with torches within the pitchers.
17 He said to them, "Watch me, and do likewise. Behold, when I come to the outermost part of the camp, it shall be that, as I do, so you shall do.
18 When I blow the trumpet, I and all who are with me, then blow the trumpets also on every side of all the camp, and shout, 'For Yahweh and for Gideon!' "
19 So Gideon and the hundred men who were with him came to the outermost part

of the camp in the beginning of the middle watch, when they had but newly set the watch. Then they blew the trumpets and broke in pieces the pitchers that were in their hands.
20 The three companies blew the trumpets, broke the pitchers, and held the torches in their left hands and the trumpets in their right hands with which to blow; and they shouted, “The sword of Yahweh and of Gideon!”
21 They each stood in his place around the camp, and all the army ran; and they shouted, and put them to flight.
22 They blew the three hundred trumpets, and Yahweh set every man’s sword against his fellow and against all the army; and the army fled as far as Beth Shittah toward Zererah, as far as the border of Abel Meholah, by Tabbath.
23 The men of Israel were gathered together out of Naphtali, out of Asher, and out of all Manasseh, and pursued Midian.
24 Gideon sent messengers throughout all the hill country of Ephraim, saying, “Come down against Midian and take the waters before them as far as Beth Barah, even the Jordan!” So all the men of Ephraim were gathered together and took the waters as far as Beth Barah, even the Jordan.
25 They took the two princes of Midian, Oreb and Zeeb. They killed Oreb at Oreb’s rock, and Zeeb they killed at Zeeb’s wine press, as they pursued Midian. Then they brought the heads of Oreb and Zeeb to Gideon beyond the Jordan.

8

1 The men of Ephraim said to him, “Why have you treated us this way, that you didn’t call us when you went to fight with Midian?” They rebuked him sharply.
2 He said to them, “What have I now done in comparison with you? Isn’t the gleaning of the grapes of Ephraim better than the vintage of Abiezer?
3 God has delivered into your hand the princes of Midian, Oreb and Zeeb! What was I able to do in comparison with you?” Then their anger was abated toward him when he had said that.
4 Gideon came to the Jordan and passed over, he and the three hundred men who were with him, faint, yet pursuing.
5 He said to the men of Succoth, “Please give loaves of bread to the people who follow me; for they are faint, and I am pursuing after Zebah and Zalmunna, the kings of Midian.”
6 The princes of Succoth said, “Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in your hand, that we should give bread to your army?”
7 Gideon said, “Therefore when Yahweh has delivered Zebah and Zalmunna into my hand, then I will tear your flesh with the thorns of the wilderness and with briers.”
8 He went up there to Penuel, and spoke to them in the same way; and the men of Penuel answered him as the men of Succoth had answered.
9 He spoke also to the men of Penuel, saying, “When I come again in peace, I will break down this tower.”
10 Now Zebah and Zalmunna were in Karkor, and their armies with them, about fifteen thousand men, all who were left of all the army of the children of the east; for there fell one hundred twenty thousand men who drew sword.
11 Gideon went up by the way of those who lived in tents on the east of Nobah and Jogbehah, and struck the army; for the army felt secure.
12 Zebah and Zalmunna fled and he pursued them. He took the two kings of Midian, Zebah and Zalmunna, and confused all the army.
13 Gideon the son of Joash returned from the battle from the ascent of Heres.
14 He caught a young man of the men of Succoth, and inquired of him; and he described for him the princes of Succoth, and its elders, seventy-seven men.
15 He came to the men of Succoth, and said, “See Zebah and Zalmunna, concerning whom you taunted me, saying, ‘Are the hands of Zebah and Zalmunna now in your hand, that we should give bread to your men who are weary?’ ”

16 He took the elders of the city, and
thorns of the wilderness and briers, and
with them he taught the men of Succoth.
17 He broke down the tower of Penuel,
and killed the men of the city.
18 Then he said to Zebah and Zalmunna,
"What kind of men were they whom you
killed at Tabor?"
They answered, "They were like you.
They all resembled the children of a king."
19 He said, "They were my brothers, the
sons of my mother. As Yahweh lives, if
you had saved them alive, I would not kill
you."
20 He said to Jether his firstborn, "Get up
and kill them!" But the youth didn't draw
his sword; for he was afraid, because he
was yet a youth.
21 Then Zebah and Zalmunna said, "You
rise and fall on us; for as the man is, so is
his strength." Gideon arose, and killed
Zebah and Zalmunna, and took the
crescents that were on their camels'
necks.
22 Then the men of Israel said to Gideon,
"Rule over us, both you, your son, and
your son's son also; for you have saved us
out of the hand of Midian."
23 Gideon said to them, "I will not rule
over you, neither shall my son rule over
you. Yahweh shall rule over you."
24 Gideon said to them, "I do have a
request: that you would each give me the
earrings of his plunder." (For they had
golden earrings, because they were
Ishmaelites.)
25 They answered, "We will willingly
give them." They spread a garment, and
every man threw the earrings of his
plunder into it.
26 The weight of the golden earrings that
he requested was one thousand and seven
hundred shekels† of gold, in addition to
the crescents, and the pendants, and the
purple clothing that was on the kings of
Midian, and in addition to the chains that
were about their camels' necks.
27 Gideon made an ephod out of it, and
put it in Ophrah, his city. Then all Israel
played the prostitute with it there; and it
became a snare to Gideon and to his
house.
28 So Midian was subdued before the
children of Israel, and they lifted up their
heads no more. The land had rest forty
years in the days of Gideon.
29 Jerubbaal the son of Joash went and
lived in his own house.
30 Gideon had seventy sons conceived
from his body, for he had many wives.
31 His concubine who was in Shechem
also bore him a son, and he named him
Abimelech.
32 Gideon the son of Joash died in a good
old age, and was buried in the tomb of
Joash his father, in Ophrah of the
Abiezrites.
33 As soon as Gideon was dead, the
children of Israel turned again and played
the prostitute following the Baals, and
made Baal Berith their god.
34 The children of Israel didn't
remember Yahweh their God, who had
delivered them out of the hand of all their
enemies on every side;
35 neither did they show kindness to the
house of Jerubbaal, that is, Gideon,
according to all the goodness which he
had shown to Israel.

9

1 Abimelech the son of Jerubbaal went
to Shechem to his mother's brothers, and
spoke with them and with all the family of
the house of his mother's father, saying,
2 "Please speak in the ears of all the men
of Shechem, 'Is it better for you that all the
sons of Jerubbaal, who are seventy
persons, rule over you, or that one rule
over you?' Remember also that I am your
bone and your flesh."
3 His mother's brothers spoke of him in
the ears of all the men of Shechem all
these words. Their hearts inclined to
follow Abimelech; for they said, "He is our
brother."
4 They gave him seventy pieces of silver
out of the house of Baal Berith, with
which Abimelech hired vain and reckless
fellows who followed him.
5 He went to his father's house at
Ophrah, and killed his brothers the sons

† **8:26** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 1700 shekels is about 17 kilograms or 37.4 pounds.

of Jerubbaal, being seventy persons, on one stone; but Jotham the youngest son of Jerubbaal was left, for he hid himself.
6 All the men of Shechem assembled themselves together with all the house of Millo, and went and made Abimelech king by the oak of the pillar that was in Shechem.
7 When they told it to Jotham, he went and stood on the top of Mount Gerizim and lifted up his voice, cried out, and said to them, "Listen to me, you men of Shechem, that God may listen to you.
8 The trees set out to anoint a king over themselves. They said to the olive tree, 'Reign over us.'
9 "But the olive tree said to them, 'Should I stop producing my oil, with which they honor God and man by me, and go to wave back and forth over the trees?'
10 "The trees said to the fig tree, 'Come and reign over us.'
11 "But the fig tree said to them, 'Should I leave my sweetness, and my good fruit, and go to wave back and forth over the trees?'
12 "The trees said to the vine, 'Come and reign over us.'
13 "The vine said to them, 'Should I leave my new wine, which cheers God and man, and go to wave back and forth over the trees?'
14 "Then all the trees said to the bramble, 'Come and reign over us.'
15 "The bramble said to the trees, 'If in truth you anoint me king over you, then come and take refuge in my shade; and if not, let fire come out of the bramble, and devour the cedars of Lebanon.'
16 "Now therefore, if you have dealt truly and righteously, in that you have made Abimelech king, and if you have dealt well with Jerubbaal and his house, and have done to him according to the deserving of his hands
17 (for my father fought for you, risked his life, and delivered you out of the hand of Midian;
18 and you have risen up against my father's house today and have slain his sons, seventy persons, on one stone, and have made Abimelech, the son of his female servant, king over the men of Shechem, because he is your brother);
19 if you then have dealt truly and righteously with Jerubbaal and with his house today, then rejoice in Abimelech, and let him also rejoice in you;
20 but if not, let fire come out from Abimelech and devour the men of Shechem and the house of Millo; and let fire come out from the men of Shechem and from the house of Millo and devour Abimelech."
21 Jotham ran away and fled, and went to Beer† and lived there, for fear of Abimelech his brother.
22 Abimelech was prince over Israel three years.
23 Then God sent an evil spirit between Abimelech and the men of Shechem; and the men of Shechem dealt treacherously with Abimelech,
24 that the violence done to the seventy sons of Jerubbaal might come, and that their blood might be laid on Abimelech their brother who killed them, and on the men of Shechem who strengthened his hands to kill his brothers.
25 The men of Shechem set an ambush for him on the tops of the mountains, and they robbed all who came along that way by them; and Abimelech was told about it.
26 Gaal the son of Ebed came with his brothers and went over to Shechem; and the men of Shechem put their trust in him.
27 They went out into the field, harvested their vineyards, trod the grapes, celebrated, and went into the house of their god and ate and drank, and cursed Abimelech.
28 Gaal the son of Ebed said, "Who is Abimelech, and who is Shechem, that we should serve him? Isn't he the son of Jerubbaal? Isn't Zebul his officer? Serve the men of Hamor the father of Shechem, but why should we serve him?
29 I wish that this people were under my hand! Then I would remove Abimelech."

† **9:21** "Beer" is Hebrew for "well", i.e., a village named for its well.

He said to Abimelech, “Increase your army and come out!”

30 When Zebul the ruler of the city heard the words of Gaal the son of Ebed, his anger burned.

31 He sent messengers to Abimelech craftily, saying, “Behold, Gaal the son of Ebed and his brothers have come to Shechem; and behold, they incite the city against you.

32 Now therefore, go up by night, you and the people who are with you, and lie in wait in the field.

33 It shall be that in the morning, as soon as the sun is up, you shall rise early and rush on the city. Behold, when he and the people who are with him come out against you, then may you do to them as you shall find occasion.”

34 Abimelech rose up, and all the people who were with him, by night, and they laid wait against Shechem in four companies.

35 Gaal the son of Ebed went out, and stood in the entrance of the gate of the city. Abimelech rose up, and the people who were with him, from the ambush.

36 When Gaal saw the people, he said to Zebul, “Behold, people are coming down from the tops of the mountains.”

Zebul said to him, “You see the shadows of the mountains as if they were men.”

37 Gaal spoke again and said, “Behold, people are coming down by the middle of the land, and one company comes by the way of the oak of Meonenim.”

38 Then Zebul said to him, “Now where is your mouth, that you said, ‘Who is Abimelech, that we should serve him?’ Isn’t this the people that you have despised? Please go out now and fight with them.”

39 Gaal went out before the men of Shechem, and fought with Abimelech.

40 Abimelech chased him, and he fled before him, and many fell wounded, even to the entrance of the gate.

41 Abimelech lived at Arumah; and Zebul drove out Gaal and his brothers, that they should not dwell in Shechem.

42 On the next day, the people went out into the field; and they told Abimelech.

43 He took the people and divided them into three companies, and laid wait in the field; and he looked, and behold, the people came out of the city. So, he rose up against them and struck them.

44 Abimelech and the companies that were with him rushed forward and stood in the entrance of the gate of the city; and the two companies rushed on all who were in the field and struck them.

45 Abimelech fought against the city all that day; and he took the city and killed the people in it. He beat down the city and sowed it with salt.

46 When all the men of the tower of Shechem heard of it, they entered into the stronghold of the house of Elberith.

47 Abimelech was told that all the men of the tower of Shechem were gathered together.

48 Abimelech went up to Mount Zalmon, he and all the people who were with him; and Abimelech took an ax in his hand, and cut down a bough from the trees, and took it up, and laid it on his shoulder. Then he said to the people who were with him, “What you have seen me do, make haste, and do as I have done!”

49 All the people likewise each cut down his bough, followed Abimelech, and put them at the base of the stronghold, and set the stronghold on fire over them, so that all the people of the tower of Shechem died also, about a thousand men and women.

50 Then Abimelech went to Thebez and encamped against Thebez, and took it.

51 But there was a strong tower within the city, and all the men and women of the city fled there, and shut themselves in, and went up to the roof of the tower.

52 Abimelech came to the tower and fought against it, and came near to the door of the tower to burn it with fire.

53 A certain woman cast an upper millstone on Abimelech’s head, and broke his skull.

54 Then he called hastily to the young man, his armor bearer, and said to him, “Draw your sword and kill me, that men

not say of me, ‘A woman killed him.’ His young man thrust him through, and he died.”
55 When the men of Israel saw that Abimelech was dead, they each departed to his place.
56 Thus God repaid the wickedness of Abimelech, which he did to his father in killing his seventy brothers;
57 and God repaid all the wickedness of the men of Shechem on their heads; and the curse of Jotham the son of Jerubbaal came on them.

10

1 After Abimelech, Tola the son of Puah, the son of Dodo, a man of Issachar, arose to save Israel. He lived in Shamir in the hill country of Ephraim.
2 He judged Israel twenty-three years, and died, and was buried in Shamir.
3 After him Jair, the Gileadite, arose. He judged Israel twenty-two years.
4 He had thirty sons who rode on thirty donkey colts. They had thirty cities, which are called Havvoth Jair to this day, which are in the land of Gilead.
5 Jair died, and was buried in Kamon.
6 The children of Israel again did that which was evil in Yahweh’s sight, and served the Baals, the Ashtaroth, the gods of Syria, the gods of Sidon, the gods of Moab, the gods of the children of Ammon, and the gods of the Philistines. They abandoned Yahweh, and didn’t serve him.
7 Yahweh’s anger burned against Israel, and he sold them into the hand of the Philistines and into the hand of the children of Ammon.
8 They troubled and oppressed the children of Israel that year. For eighteen years they oppressed all the children of Israel that were beyond the Jordan in the land of the Amorites, which is in Gilead.
9 The children of Ammon passed over the Jordan to fight also against Judah, and against Benjamin, and against the house of Ephraim, so that Israel was very distressed.
10 The children of Israel cried to Yahweh, saying, “We have sinned against you, even because we have forsaken our God, and have served the Baals.”
11 Yahweh said to the children of Israel, “Didn’t I save you from the Egyptians, and from the Amorites, from the children of Ammon, and from the Philistines?
12 The Sidonians also, and the Amalekites, and the Maonites, oppressed you; and you cried to me, and I saved you out of their hand.
13 Yet you have forsaken me and served other gods. Therefore I will save you no more.
14 Go and cry to the gods which you have chosen. Let them save you in the time of your distress!”
15 The children of Israel said to Yahweh, “We have sinned! Do to us whatever seems good to you; only deliver us, please, today.”
16 They put away the foreign gods from among them and served Yahweh; and his soul was grieved for the misery of Israel.
17 Then the children of Ammon were gathered together and encamped in Gilead. The children of Israel assembled themselves together and encamped in Mizpah.
18 The people, the princes of Gilead, said to one another, “Who is the man who will begin to fight against the children of Ammon? He shall be head over all the inhabitants of Gilead.”

11

1 Now Jephthah the Gileadite was a mighty man of valor. He was the son of a prostitute. Gilead became the father of Jephthah.
2 Gilead’s wife bore him sons. When his wife’s sons grew up, they drove Jephthah out and said to him, “You will not inherit in our father’s house, for you are the son of another woman.”
3 Then Jephthah fled from his brothers and lived in the land of Tob. Outlaws joined up with Jephthah, and they went out with him.
4 After a while, the children of Ammon made war against Israel.
5 When the children of Ammon made war against Israel, the elders of Gilead went to get Jephthah out of the land of Tob.

6 They said to Jephthah, “Come and be
our chief, that we may fight with the
children of Ammon.”
7 Jephthah said to the elders of Gilead,
“Didn’t you hate me, and drive me out of
my father’s house? Why have you come to
me now when you are in distress?”
8 The elders of Gilead said to Jephthah,
“Therefore we have turned again to you
now, that you may go with us and fight
with the children of Ammon. You will be
our head over all the inhabitants of
Gilead.”
9 Jephthah said to the elders of Gilead,
“If you bring me home again to fight with
the children of Ammon, and Yahweh
delivers them before me, will I be your
head?”
10 The elders of Gilead said to Jephthah,
“Yahweh will be witness between us.
Surely we will do what you say.”
11 Then Jephthah went with the elders
of Gilead, and the people made him head
and chief over them. Jephthah spoke all
his words before Yahweh in Mizpah.
12 Jephthah sent messengers to the king
of the children of Ammon, saying, “What
do you have to do with me, that you have
come to me to fight against my land?”
13 The king of the children of Ammon
answered the messengers of Jephthah,
“Because Israel took away my land when
he came up out of Egypt, from the Arnon
even to the Jabbok, and to the Jordan.
Now therefore restore that territory again
peaceably.”
14 Jephthah sent messengers again to
the king of the children of Ammon;
15 and he said to him, “Jephthah says:
Israel didn’t take away the land of Moab,
nor the land of the children of Ammon;
16 but when they came up from Egypt,
and Israel went through the wilderness to
the Red Sea, and came to Kadesh,
17 then Israel sent messengers to the
king of Edom, saying, ‘Please let me pass
through your land;’ but the king of Edom
didn’t listen. In the same way, he sent to
the king of Moab, but he refused; so Israel
stayed in Kadesh.
18 Then they went through the
wilderness, and went around the land of
Edom, and the land of Moab, and came by
the east side of the land of Moab, and they
encamped on the other side of the Arnon;
but they didn’t come within the border of
Moab, for the Arnon was the border of
Moab.
19 Israel sent messengers to Sihon king
of the Amorites, the king of Heshbon; and
Israel said to him, ‘Please let us pass
through your land to my place.’
20 But Sihon didn’t trust Israel to pass
through his border; but Sihon gathered all
his people together, and encamped in
Jahaz, and fought against Israel.
21 Yahweh, the God of Israel, delivered
Sihon and all his people into the hand of
Israel, and they struck them. So Israel
possessed all the land of the Amorites, the
inhabitants of that country.
22 They possessed all the border of the
Amorites, from the Arnon even to the
Jabbok, and from the wilderness even to
the Jordan.
23 So now Yahweh, the God of Israel, has
dispossessed the Amorites from before his
people Israel, and should you possess
them?
24 Won’t you possess that which
Chemosh your god gives you to possess?
So whoever Yahweh our God has
dispossessed from before us, them will we
possess.
25 Now are you anything better than
Balak the son of Zippor, king of Moab? Did
he ever strive against Israel, or did he
ever fight against them?
26 Israel lived in Heshbon and its towns,
and in Aroer and its towns, and in all the
cities that are along the side of the Arnon
for three hundred years! Why didn’t you
recover them within that time?
27 Therefore I have not sinned against
you, but you do me wrong to war against
me. May Yahweh the Judge be judge today
between the children of Israel and the
children of Ammon.”
28 However, the king of the children of
Ammon didn’t listen to the words of
Jephthah which he sent him.
29 Then Yahweh’s Spirit came on

Jephthah, and he passed over Gilead and Manasseh, and passed over Mizpah of Gilead, and from Mizpah of Gilead he passed over to the children of Ammon.

30 Jephthah vowed a vow to Yahweh, and said, “If you will indeed deliver the children of Ammon into my hand,
31 then it shall be, that whatever comes out of the doors of my house to meet me when I return in peace from the children of Ammon, it shall be Yahweh’s, and I will offer it up for a burnt offering.”

32 So Jephthah passed over to the children of Ammon to fight against them; and Yahweh delivered them into his hand.
33 He struck them from Aroer until you come to Minnith, even twenty cities, and to Abelcheramim, with a very great slaughter. So the children of Ammon were subdued before the children of Israel.

34 Jephthah came to Mizpah to his house; and behold, his daughter came out to meet him with tambourines and with dances. She was his only child. Besides her he had neither son nor daughter.
35 When he saw her, he tore his clothes, and said, “Alas, my daughter! You have brought me very low, and you are one of those who trouble me; for I have opened my mouth to Yahweh, and I can’t go back.”

36 She said to him, “My father, you have opened your mouth to Yahweh; do to me according to that which has proceeded out of your mouth, because Yahweh has taken vengeance for you on your enemies, even on the children of Ammon.”
37 Then she said to her father, “Let this thing be done for me. Leave me alone two months, that I may depart and go down on the mountains, and bewail my virginity, I and my companions.”

38 He said, “Go.” He sent her away for two months; and she departed, she and her companions, and mourned her virginity on the mountains.
39 At the end of two months, she returned to her father, who did with her according to his vow which he had vowed. She was a virgin. It became a custom in Israel
40 that the daughters of Israel went yearly to celebrate the daughter of Jephthah the Gileadite four days in a year.

12

1 The men of Ephraim were gathered together, and passed northward; and they said to Jephthah, “Why did you pass over to fight against the children of Ammon, and didn’t call us to go with you? We will burn your house around you with fire!”
2 Jephthah said to them, “I and my people were at great strife with the children of Ammon; and when I called you, you didn’t save me out of their hand.
3 When I saw that you didn’t save me, I put my life in my hand, and passed over against the children of Ammon, and Yahweh delivered them into my hand. Why then have you come up to me today, to fight against me?”

4 Then Jephthah gathered together all the men of Gilead, and fought with Ephraim. The men of Gilead struck Ephraim, because they said, “You are fugitives of Ephraim, you Gileadites, in the middle of Ephraim, and in the middle of Manasseh.”
5 The Gileadites took the fords of the Jordan against the Ephraimites. Whenever a fugitive of Ephraim said, “Let me go over,” the men of Gilead said to him, “Are you an Ephraimite?” If he said, “No;”
6 then they said to him, “Now say ‘Shibboleth;’ ” and he said “Sibboleth”; for he couldn’t manage to pronounce it correctly, then they seized him and killed him at the fords of the Jordan. At that time, forty-two thousand of Ephraim fell.

7 Jephthah judged Israel six years. Then Jephthah the Gileadite died, and was buried in the cities of Gilead.
8 After him Ibzan of Bethlehem judged Israel.
9 He had thirty sons. He sent his thirty daughters outside his clan, and he brought in thirty daughters from outside his clan for his sons. He judged Israel seven years.
10 Ibzan died, and was buried at Bethlehem.

11 After him, Elon the Zebulunite judged
Israel; and he judged Israel ten years.
12 Elon the Zebulunite died, and was
buried in Aijalon in the land of Zebulun.
13 After him, Abdon the son of Hillel the
Pirathonite judged Israel.
14 He had forty sons and thirty sons'
sons who rode on seventy donkey colts.
He judged Israel eight years.
15 Abdon the son of Hillel the
Pirathonite died, and was buried in
Pirathon in the land of Ephraim, in the hill
country of the Amalekites.

13

1 The children of Israel again did that
which was evil in Yahweh's sight; and
Yahweh delivered them into the hand of
the Philistines forty years.
2 There was a certain man of Zorah, of
the family of the Danites, whose name
was Manoah; and his wife was barren,
and childless.
3 Yahweh's angel appeared to the
woman, and said to her, "See now, you are
barren and childless; but you shall
conceive and bear a son.
4 Now therefore please beware and
drink no wine nor strong drink, and don't
eat any unclean thing;
5 for, behold, you shall conceive and
give birth to a son. No razor shall come on
his head, for the child shall be a Nazirite
to God from the womb. He shall begin to
save Israel out of the hand of the
Philistines."
6 Then the woman came and told her
husband, saying, "A man of God came to
me, and his face was like the face of the
angel of God, very awesome. I didn't ask
him where he was from, neither did he
tell me his name;
7 but he said to me, 'Behold, you shall
conceive and bear a son; and now drink
no wine nor strong drink. Don't eat any
unclean thing, for the child shall be a
Nazirite to God from the womb to the day
of his death.' "
8 Then Manoah entreated Yahweh, and
said, "Oh, Lord, please let the man of God
whom you sent come again to us, and
teach us what we should do to the child
who shall be born."
9 God listened to the voice of Manoah,
and the angel of God came again to the
woman as she sat in the field; but
Manoah, her husband, wasn't with her.
10 The woman hurried and ran, and told
her husband, saying to him, "Behold, the
man who came to me that day has
appeared to me."
11 Manoah arose and followed his wife,
and came to the man, and said to him,
"Are you the man who spoke to my wife?"
He said, "I am."
12 Manoah said, "Now let your words
happen. What shall the child's way of life
and mission be?"
13 Yahweh's angel said to Manoah, "Of
all that I said to the woman let her beware.
14 She may not eat of anything that
comes of the vine, neither let her drink
wine or strong drink, nor eat any unclean
thing. Let her observe all that I
commanded her."
15 Manoah said to Yahweh's angel,
"Please stay with us, that we may make a
young goat ready for you."
16 Yahweh's angel said to Manoah,
"Though you detain me, I won't eat your
bread. If you will prepare a burnt
offering, you must offer it to Yahweh." For
Manoah didn't know that he was
Yahweh's angel.
17 Manoah said to Yahweh's angel,
"What is your name, that when your
words happen, we may honor you?"
18 Yahweh's angel said to him, "Why do
you ask about my name, since it is
incomprehensible†?"
19 So Manoah took the young goat with
the meal offering, and offered it on the
rock to Yahweh. Then the angel did an
amazing thing as Manoah and his wife
watched.
20 For when the flame went up toward
the sky from off the altar, Yahweh's angel
ascended in the flame of the altar.
Manoah and his wife watched; and they
fell on their faces to the ground.
21 But Yahweh's angel didn't appear to
Manoah or to his wife any more. Then

† **13:18** or, wonderful

Manoah knew that he was Yahweh's angel.
22 Manoah said to his wife, "We shall surely die, because we have seen God."
23 But his wife said to him, "If Yahweh were pleased to kill us, he wouldn't have received a burnt offering and a meal offering at our hand, and he wouldn't have shown us all these things, nor would he have told us such things as these at this time."
24 The woman bore a son and named him Samson. The child grew, and Yahweh blessed him.
25 Yahweh's Spirit began to move him in Mahaneh Dan, between Zorah and Eshtaol.

14

1 Samson went down to Timnah, and saw a woman in Timnah of the daughters of the Philistines.
2 He came up, and told his father and his mother, saying, "I have seen a woman in Timnah of the daughters of the Philistines. Now therefore get her for me as my wife."
3 Then his father and his mother said to him, "Isn't there a woman among your brothers' daughters, or among all my people, that you go to take a wife of the uncircumcised Philistines?"
Samson said to his father, "Get her for me, for she pleases me well."
4 But his father and his mother didn't know that it was of Yahweh; for he sought an occasion against the Philistines. Now at that time the Philistines ruled over Israel.
5 Then Samson went down to Timnah with his father and his mother, and came to the vineyards of Timnah; and behold, a young lion roared at him.
6 Yahweh's Spirit came mightily on him, and he tore him as he would have torn a young goat with his bare hands, but he didn't tell his father or his mother what he had done.
7 He went down and talked with the woman, and she pleased Samson well.
8 After a while he returned to take her, and he went over to see the carcass of the lion; and behold, there was a swarm of bees in the body of the lion, and honey.
9 He took it into his hands, and went on, eating as he went. He came to his father and mother and gave to them, and they ate, but he didn't tell them that he had taken the honey out of the lion's body.
10 His father went down to the woman; and Samson made a feast there, for the young men used to do so.
11 When they saw him, they brought thirty companions to be with him.
12 Samson said to them, "Let me tell you a riddle now. If you can tell me the answer within the seven days of the feast, and find it out, then I will give you thirty linen garments and thirty changes of clothing;
13 but if you can't tell me the answer, then you shall give me thirty linen garments and thirty changes of clothing."
They said to him, "Tell us your riddle, that we may hear it."
14 He said to them,
"Out of the eater came out food.
Out of the strong came out sweetness."
They couldn't in three days declare the riddle.
15 On the seventh day, they said to Samson's wife, "Entice your husband, that he may declare to us the riddle, lest we burn you and your father's house with fire. Have you called us to impoverish us? Isn't that so?"
16 Samson's wife wept before him, and said, "You just hate me, and don't love me. You've told a riddle to the children of my people, and haven't told it to me."
He said to her, "Behold, I haven't told my father or my mother, so why should I tell you?"
17 She wept before him the seven days, while their feast lasted; and on the seventh day, he told her, because she pressed him severely; and she told the riddle to the children of her people.
18 The men of the city said to him on the seventh day before the sun went down, "What is sweeter than honey? What is stronger than a lion?"
He said to them,
"If you hadn't plowed with my heifer,
you wouldn't have found out my riddle."
19 Yahweh's Spirit came mightily on him, and he went down to Ashkelon and

struck thirty men of them. He took their plunder, then gave the changes of clothing to those who declared the riddle. His anger burned, and he went up to his father's house.
20 But Samson's wife was given to his companion, who had been his friend.

15

1 But after a while, in the time of wheat harvest, Samson visited his wife with a young goat. He said, "I will go in to my wife's room."
But her father wouldn't allow him to go in.
2 Her father said, "I most certainly thought that you utterly hated her; therefore I gave her to your companion. Isn't her younger sister more beautiful than she? Please, take her instead."
3 Samson said to them, "This time I will be blameless in the case of the Philistines when I harm them."
4 Samson went and caught three hundred foxes, and took torches, and turned tail to tail, and put a torch in the middle between every two tails.
5 When he had set the torches on fire, he let them go into the standing grain of the Philistines, and burned up both the shocks and the standing grain, and also the olive groves.
6 Then the Philistines said, "Who has done this?"
They said, "Samson, the son-in-law of the Timnite, because he has taken his wife and given her to his companion." The Philistines came up, and burned her and her father with fire.
7 Samson said to them, "If you behave like this, surely I will take revenge on you, and after that I will cease."
8 He struck them hip and thigh with a great slaughter; and he went down and lived in the cave in Etam's rock.
9 Then the Philistines went up, encamped in Judah, and spread themselves in Lehi.
10 The men of Judah said, "Why have you come up against us?"
They said, "We have come up to bind Samson, to do to him as he has done to us."
11 Then three thousand men of Judah went down to the cave in Etam's rock, and said to Samson, "Don't you know that the Philistines are rulers over us? What then is this that you have done to us?"
He said to them, "As they did to me, so I have done to them."
12 They said to him, "We have come down to bind you, that we may deliver you into the hand of the Philistines."
Samson said to them, "Swear to me that you will not attack me yourselves."
13 They spoke to him, saying, "No, but we will bind you securely and deliver you into their hands; but surely we will not kill you." They bound him with two new ropes, and brought him up from the rock.
14 When he came to Lehi, the Philistines shouted as they met him. Then Yahweh's Spirit came mightily on him, and the ropes that were on his arms became as flax that was burned with fire; and his bands dropped from off his hands.
15 He found a fresh jawbone of a donkey, put out his hand, took it, and struck a thousand men with it.
16 Samson said, "With the jawbone of a donkey, heaps on heaps; with the jawbone of a donkey I have struck a thousand men."
17 When he had finished speaking, he threw the jawbone out of his hand; and that place was called Ramath Lehi.†
18 He was very thirsty, and called on Yahweh and said, "You have given this great deliverance by the hand of your servant; and now shall I die of thirst, and fall into the hands of the uncircumcised?"
19 But God split the hollow place that is in Lehi, and water came out of it. When he had drunk, his spirit came again, and he revived. Therefore its name was called En Hakkore, which is in Lehi, to this day.
20 He judged Israel twenty years in the days of the Philistines.

16

1 Samson went to Gaza, and saw there a prostitute, and went in to her.
2 The Gazites were told, "Samson is here!" They surrounded him and laid wait

† **15:17** "Ramath" means "hill" and "Lehi" means "jawbone".

for him all night in the gate of the city, and were quiet all the night, saying, “Wait until morning light; then we will kill him.”
3 Samson lay until midnight, then arose at midnight and took hold of the doors of the gate of the city, with the two posts, and plucked them up, bar and all, and put them on his shoulders and carried them up to the top of the mountain that is before Hebron.
4 It came to pass afterward that he loved a woman in the valley of Sorek, whose name was Delilah.
5 The lords of the Philistines came up to her and said to her, “Entice him, and see in which his great strength lies, and by what means we may prevail against him, that we may bind him to afflict him; and we will each give you eleven hundred pieces of silver.”
6 Delilah said to Samson, “Please tell me where your great strength lies, and what you might be bound to afflict you.”
7 Samson said to her, “If they bind me with seven green cords that were never dried, then shall I become weak, and be as another man.”
8 Then the lords of the Philistines brought up to her seven green cords which had not been dried, and she bound him with them.
9 Now she had an ambush waiting in the inner room. She said to him, “The Philistines are on you, Samson!” He broke the cords as a flax thread is broken when it touches the fire. So his strength was not known.
10 Delilah said to Samson, “Behold, you have mocked me, and told me lies. Now please tell me how you might be bound.”
11 He said to her, “If they only bind me with new ropes with which no work has been done, then I will become weak, and be as another man.”
12 So Delilah took new ropes and bound him with them, then said to him, “The Philistines are on you, Samson!” The ambush was waiting in the inner room. He broke them off his arms like a thread.
13 Delilah said to Samson, “Until now, you have mocked me and told me lies. Tell me with what you might be bound.”

He said to her, “If you weave the seven locks of my head with the fabric on the loom.”
14 She fastened it with the pin, and said to him, “The Philistines are on you, Samson!” He awakened out of his sleep, and plucked away the pin of the beam and the fabric.
15 She said to him, “How can you say, ‘I love you,’ when your heart is not with me? You have mocked me these three times, and have not told me where your great strength lies.”
16 When she pressed him daily with her words and urged him, his soul was troubled to death.
17 He told her all his heart and said to her, “No razor has ever come on my head; for I have been a Nazirite to God from my mother’s womb. If I am shaved, then my strength will go from me and I will become weak, and be like any other man.”
18 When Delilah saw that he had told her all his heart, she sent and called for the lords of the Philistines, saying, “Come up this once, for he has told me all his heart.” Then the lords of the Philistines came up to her and brought the money in their hand.
19 She made him sleep on her knees; and she called for a man and shaved off the seven locks of his head; and she began to afflict him, and his strength went from him.
20 She said, “The Philistines are upon you, Samson!”

He awoke out of his sleep, and said, “I will go out as at other times, and shake myself free.” But he didn’t know that Yahweh had departed from him.
21 The Philistines laid hold on him and put out his eyes; and they brought him down to Gaza and bound him with fetters of bronze; and he ground at the mill in the prison.
22 However, the hair of his head began to grow again after he was shaved.
23 The lords of the Philistines gathered together to offer a great sacrifice to Dagon their god, and to rejoice; for they said, “Our god has delivered Samson our enemy into our hand.”

24 When the people saw him, they
praised their god; for they said, “Our god
has delivered our enemy and the
destroyer of our country, who has slain
many of us, into our hand.”
25 When their hearts were merry, they
said, “Call for Samson, that he may
entertain us.” They called for Samson out
of the prison; and he performed before
them. They set him between the pillars;
26 and Samson said to the boy who held
him by the hand, “Allow me to feel the
pillars on which the house rests, that I
may lean on them.”
27 Now the house was full of men and
women; and all the lords of the Philistines
were there; and there were on the roof
about three thousand men and women,
who saw while Samson performed.
28 Samson called to Yahweh, and said,
“Lord Yahweh, remember me, please, and
strengthen me, please, only this once,
God, that I may be at once avenged of the
Philistines for my two eyes.”
29 Samson took hold of the two middle
pillars on which the house rested and
leaned on them, the one with his right
hand and the other with his left.
30 Samson said, “Let me die with the
Philistines!” He bowed himself with all
his might; and the house fell on the lords,
and on all the people who were in it. So
the dead that he killed at his death were
more than those who he killed in his life.
31 Then his brothers and all the house of
his father came down and took him, and
brought him up and buried him between
Zorah and Eshtaol in the burial site of
Manoah his father. He judged Israel
twenty years.

17

1 There was a man of the hill country of
Ephraim, whose name was Micah.
2 He said to his mother, “The eleven
hundred pieces of silver that were taken
from you, about which you uttered a
curse, and also spoke it in my
ears—behold, the silver is with me. I took
it.”
His mother said, “May Yahweh bless my
son!”
3 He restored the eleven hundred pieces
of silver to his mother, then his mother
said, “I most certainly dedicate the silver
to Yahweh from my hand for my son, to
make a carved image and a molten image.
Now therefore I will restore it to you.”
4 When he restored the money to his
mother, his mother took two hundred
pieces of silver, and gave them to a
silversmith, who made a carved image
and a molten image out of it. It was in the
house of Micah.
5 The man Micah had a house of gods,
and he made an ephod, and teraphim,† and consecrated one of his sons, who
became his priest.
6 In those days there was no king in
Israel. Everyone did that which was right
in his own eyes.
7 There was a young man out of
Bethlehem Judah, of the family of Judah,
who was a Levite; and he lived there.
8 The man departed out of the city, out
of Bethlehem Judah, to live where he
could find a place, and he came to the hill
country of Ephraim, to the house of
Micah, as he traveled.
9 Micah said to him, “Where did you
come from?”
He said to him, “I am a Levite of
Bethlehem Judah, and I am looking for a
place to live.”
10 Micah said to him, “Dwell with me,
and be to me a father and a priest, and I
will give you ten pieces of silver per year,
a suit of clothing, and your food.” So the
Levite went in.
11 The Levite was content to dwell with
the man; and the young man was to him
as one of his sons.
12 Micah consecrated the Levite, and the
young man became his priest, and was in
the house of Micah.
13 Then Micah said, “Now I know that
Yahweh will do good to me, since I have a
Levite as my priest.”

† **17:5** teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

18

1 In those days there was no king in
Israel. In those days the tribe of the
Danites sought an inheritance to dwell in;
for to that day, their inheritance had not
fallen to them among the tribes of Israel.
2 The children of Dan sent five men of
their family from their whole number,
men of valor, from Zorah and from
Eshtaol, to spy out the land and to search
it. They said to them, “Go, explore the
land!”
They came to the hill country of
Ephraim, to the house of Micah, and
lodged there.
3 When they were by the house of
Micah, they knew the voice of the young
man the Levite; so they went over there
and said to him, “Who brought you here?
What do you do in this place? What do
you have here?”
4 He said to them, “Thus and thus has
Micah dealt with me, and he has hired me,
and I have become his priest.”
5 They said to him, “Please ask counsel
of God, that we may know whether our
way which we go shall be prosperous.”
6 The priest said to them, “Go in peace.
Your way in which you go is before
Yahweh.”
7 Then the five men departed and came
to Laish and saw the people who were
there, how they lived in safety, in the way
of the Sidonians, quiet and secure; for
there was no one in the land possessing
authority, that might put them to shame
in anything, and they were far from the
Sidonians, and had no dealings with
anyone else.
8 They came to their brothers at Zorah
and Eshtaol; and their brothers asked
them, “What do you say?”
9 They said, “Arise, and let’s go up
against them; for we have seen the land,
and behold, it is very good. Do you stand
still? Don’t be slothful to go and to enter in
to possess the land.
10 When you go, you will come to an
unsuspecting people, and the land is
large; for God has given it into your hand,
a place where there is no lack of anything
that is in the earth.”
11 The family of the Danites set out from
Zorah and Eshtaol with six hundred men
armed with weapons of war.
12 They went up and encamped in
Kiriath Jearim in Judah. Therefore they
call that place Mahaneh Dan to this day.
Behold, it is behind Kiriath Jearim.
13 They passed from there to the hill
country of Ephraim, and came to the
house of Micah.
14 Then the five men who went to spy
out the country of Laish answered and
said to their brothers, “Do you know that
there is in these houses an ephod, and
teraphim,† and a carved image, and a
molten image? Now therefore consider
what you have to do.”
15 They went over there and came to the
house of the young Levite man, even to
the house of Micah, and asked him how he
was doing.
16 The six hundred men armed with
their weapons of war, who were of the
children of Dan, stood by the entrance of
the gate.
17 The five men who went to spy out the
land went up, and came in there, and took
the engraved image, the ephod, the
teraphim, and the molten image; and the
priest stood by the entrance of the gate
with the six hundred men armed with
weapons of war.
18 When these went into Micah’s house,
and took the engraved image, the ephod,
the teraphim, and the molten image, the
priest said to them, “What are you doing?”
19 They said to him, “Hold your peace,
put your hand on your mouth, and go
with us. Be a father and a priest to us. Is it
better for you to be priest to the house of
one man, or to be priest to a tribe and a
family in Israel?”
20 The priest’s heart was glad, and he
took the ephod, the teraphim, and the
engraved image, and went with the
people.

† **18:14** teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

21 So they turned and departed, and put
the little ones, the livestock, and the goods
before them.
22 When they were a good way from the
house of Micah, the men who were in the
houses near Micah's house gathered
together and overtook the children of
Dan.
23 As they called to the children of Dan,
they turned their faces, and said to Micah,
"What ails you, that you come with such a
company?"

24 He said, "You have taken away my
gods which I made, and the priest, and
have gone away! What more do I have?
How can you ask me, 'What ails you?' "

25 The children of Dan said to him,
"Don't let your voice be heard among us,
lest angry fellows fall on you, and you lose
your life, with the lives of your
household."

26 The children of Dan went their way;
and when Micah saw that they were too
strong for him, he turned and went back
to his house.
27 They took that which Micah had
made, and the priest whom he had, and
came to Laish, to a people quiet and
unsuspecting, and struck them with the
edge of the sword; then they burned the
city with fire.
28 There was no deliverer, because it
was far from Sidon, and they had no
dealings with anyone else; and it was in
the valley that lies by Beth Rehob. They
built the city and lived in it.
29 They called the name of the city Dan,
after the name of Dan their father, who
was born to Israel; however the name of
the city used to be Laish.
30 The children of Dan set up for
themselves the engraved image; and
Jonathan, the son of Gershom, the son of
Moses, and his sons were priests to the
tribe of the Danites until the day of the
captivity of the land.
31 So they set up for themselves Micah's
engraved image which he made, and it
remained all the time that God's house
was in Shiloh.

19

1 In those days, when there was no king
in Israel, there was a certain Levite living
on the farther side of the hill country of
Ephraim, who took for himself a
concubine out of Bethlehem Judah.
2 His concubine played the prostitute
against him, and went away from him to
her father's house to Bethlehem Judah,
and was there for four months.
3 Her husband arose and went after her
to speak kindly to her, to bring her again,
having his servant with him and a couple
of donkeys. She brought him into her
father's house; and when the father of the
young lady saw him, he rejoiced to meet
him.
4 His father-in-law, the young lady's
father, kept him there; and he stayed with
him three days. So they ate and drank,
and stayed there.

5 On the fourth day, they got up early in
the morning, and he rose up to depart.
The young lady's father said to his
son-in-law, "Strengthen your heart with a
morsel of bread, and afterward you shall
go your way."
6 So they sat down, ate, and drank, both
of them together. Then the young lady's
father said to the man, "Please be pleased
to stay all night, and let your heart be
merry."
7 The man rose up to depart; but his
father-in-law urged him, and he stayed
there again.
8 He arose early in the morning on the
fifth day to depart; and the young lady's
father said, "Please strengthen your heart
and stay until the day declines;" and they
both ate.
9 When the man rose up to depart, he,
and his concubine, and his servant, his
father-in-law, the young lady's father, said
to him, "Behold, now the day draws
toward evening, please stay all night.
Behold, the day is ending. Stay here, that
your heart may be merry; and tomorrow
go on your way early, that you may go
home."
10 But the man wouldn't stay that night,
but he rose up and went near Jebus (also

called Jerusalem). With him were a couple of saddled donkeys. His concubine also was with him.
11 When they were by Jebus, the day was far spent; and the servant said to his master, “Please come and let’s enter into this city of the Jebusites, and stay in it.”
12 His master said to him, “We won’t enter into the city of a foreigner that is not of the children of Israel; but we will pass over to Gibeah.”
13 He said to his servant, “Come and let’s draw near to one of these places; and we will lodge in Gibeah, or in Ramah.”
14 So they passed on and went their way; and the sun went down on them near Gibeah, which belongs to Benjamin.
15 They went over there, to go in to stay in Gibeah. He went in, and sat down in the street of the city; for there was no one who took them into his house to stay.
16 Behold, an old man came from his work out of the field at evening. Now the man was from the hill country of Ephraim, and he lived in Gibeah; but the men of the place were Benjamites.
17 He lifted up his eyes, and saw the wayfaring man in the street of the city; and the old man said, “Where are you going? Where did you come from?”
18 He said to him, “We are passing from Bethlehem Judah to the farther side of the hill country of Ephraim. I am from there, and I went to Bethlehem Judah. I am going to Yahweh’s house; and there is no one who has taken me into his house.
19 Yet there is both straw and feed for our donkeys; and there is bread and wine also for me, and for your servant, and for the young man who is with your servants. There is no lack of anything.”
20 The old man said, “Peace be to you! Just let me supply all your needs, but don’t sleep in the street.”
21 So he brought him into his house, and gave the donkeys fodder. Then they washed their feet, and ate and drank.
22 As they were making their hearts merry, behold, the men of the city, certain wicked fellows, surrounded the house, beating at the door; and they spoke to the master of the house, the old man, saying, “Bring out the man who came into your house, that we can have sex with him!”
23 The man, the master of the house, went out to them, and said to them, “No, my brothers, please don’t act so wickedly; since this man has come into my house, don’t do this folly.
24 Behold, here is my virgin daughter and his concubine. I will bring them out now. Humble them, and do with them what seems good to you; but to this man don’t do any such folly.”
25 But the men wouldn’t listen to him; so the man grabbed his concubine, and brought her out to them; and they had sex with her, and abused her all night until the morning. When the day began to dawn, they let her go.
26 Then the woman came in the dawning of the day, and fell down at the door of the man’s house where her lord was, until it was light.
27 Her lord rose up in the morning and opened the doors of the house, and went out to go his way; and behold, the woman his concubine had fallen down at the door of the house, with her hands on the threshold.
28 He said to her, “Get up, and let’s get going!” but no one answered. Then he took her up on the donkey; and the man rose up, and went to his place.
29 When he had come into his house, he took a knife and cut up his concubine, and divided her, limb by limb, into twelve pieces, and sent her throughout all the borders of Israel.
30 It was so, that all who saw it said, “Such a deed has not been done or seen from the day that the children of Israel came up out of the land of Egypt to this day! Consider it, take counsel, and speak.”

20

1 Then all the children of Israel went out, and the congregation was assembled as one man, from Dan even to Beersheba, with the land of Gilead, to Yahweh at Mizpah.
2 The chiefs of all the people, even of all the tribes of Israel, presented themselves

in the assembly of the people of God, four hundred thousand footmen who drew sword.
3 (Now the children of Benjamin heard that the children of Israel had gone up to Mizpah.) The children of Israel said, “Tell us, how did this wickedness happen?”
4 The Levite, the husband of the woman who was murdered, answered, “I came into Gibeah that belongs to Benjamin, I and my concubine, to spend the night.
5 The men of Gibeah rose against me, and surrounded the house by night. They intended to kill me and they raped my concubine, and she is dead.
6 I took my concubine and cut her in pieces, and sent her throughout all the country of the inheritance of Israel; for they have committed lewdness and folly in Israel.
7 Behold, you children of Israel, all of you, give here your advice and counsel.”
8 All the people arose as one man, saying, “None of us will go to his tent, neither will any of us turn to his house.
9 But now this is the thing which we will do to Gibeah: we will go up against it by lot;
10 and we will take ten men of one hundred throughout all the tribes of Israel, and one hundred of one thousand, and a thousand out of ten thousand to get food for the people, that they may do, when they come to Gibeah of Benjamin, according to all the folly that the men of Gibeah have done in Israel.”
11 So all the men of Israel were gathered against the city, knit together as one man.
12 The tribes of Israel sent men through all the tribe of Benjamin, saying, “What wickedness is this that has happened among you?
13 Now therefore deliver up the men, the wicked fellows who are in Gibeah, that we may put them to death and put away evil from Israel.”

But Benjamin would not listen to the voice of their brothers, the children of Israel.
14 The children of Benjamin gathered themselves together out of the cities to Gibeah, to go out to battle against the children of Israel.
15 The children of Benjamin were counted on that day out of the cities twenty-six thousand men who drew the sword, in addition to the inhabitants of Gibeah, who were counted seven hundred chosen men.
16 Among all these soldiers there were seven hundred chosen men who were left-handed. Every one of them could sling a stone at a hair and not miss.
17 The men of Israel, besides Benjamin, were counted four hundred thousand men who drew sword. All these were men of war.
18 The children of Israel arose, went up to Bethel, and asked counsel of God. They asked, “Who shall go up for us first to battle against the children of Benjamin?”

Yahweh said, “Judah first.”
19 The children of Israel rose up in the morning and encamped against Gibeah.
20 The men of Israel went out to battle against Benjamin; and the men of Israel set the battle in array against them at Gibeah.
21 The children of Benjamin came out of Gibeah, and on that day destroyed twenty-two thousand of the Israelite men down to the ground.
22 The people, the men of Israel, encouraged themselves, and set the battle again in array in the place where they set themselves in array the first day.
23 The children of Israel went up and wept before Yahweh until evening; and they asked of Yahweh, saying, “Shall I again draw near to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother?”

Yahweh said, “Go up against him.”
24 The children of Israel came near against the children of Benjamin the second day.
25 Benjamin went out against them out of Gibeah the second day, and destroyed down to the ground of the children of Israel again eighteen thousand men. All these drew the sword.
26 Then all the children of Israel and all the people went up, and came to Bethel, and wept, and sat there before Yahweh,

and fasted that day until evening; then they offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before Yahweh.
27 The children of Israel asked Yahweh (for the ark of the covenant of God was there in those days,
28 and Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron, stood before it in those days), saying, “Shall I yet again go out to battle against the children of Benjamin my brother, or shall I cease?”

Yahweh said, “Go up; for tomorrow I will deliver him into your hand.”

29 Israel set ambushes all around Gibeah.
30 The children of Israel went up against the children of Benjamin on the third day, and set themselves in array against Gibeah, as at other times.
31 The children of Benjamin went out against the people, and were drawn away from the city; and they began to strike and kill of the people as at other times, in the highways, of which one goes up to Bethel and the other to Gibeah, in the field, about thirty men of Israel.
32 The children of Benjamin said, “They are struck down before us, as at the first.” But the children of Israel said, “Let’s flee, and draw them away from the city to the highways.”
33 All the men of Israel rose up out of their place and set themselves in array at Baal Tamar. Then the ambushers of Israel broke out of their place, even out of Maareh Geba.
34 Ten thousand chosen men out of all Israel came over against Gibeah, and the battle was severe; but they didn’t know that disaster was close to them.
35 Yahweh struck Benjamin before Israel; and the children of Israel destroyed of Benjamin that day twenty-five thousand one hundred men. All these drew the sword.
36 So the children of Benjamin saw that they were struck, for the men of Israel yielded to Benjamin because they trusted the ambushers whom they had set against Gibeah.
37 The ambushers hurried, and rushed on Gibeah; then the ambushers spread out, and struck all the city with the edge of the sword.
38 Now the appointed sign between the men of Israel and the ambushers was that they should make a great cloud of smoke rise up out of the city.
39 The men of Israel turned in the battle, and Benjamin began to strike and kill of the men of Israel about thirty persons; for they said, “Surely they are struck down before us, as in the first battle.”
40 But when the cloud began to arise up out of the city in a pillar of smoke, the Benjamites looked behind them; and behold, the whole city went up in smoke to the sky.
41 The men of Israel turned, and the men of Benjamin were dismayed; for they saw that disaster had come on them.
42 Therefore they turned their backs before the men of Israel to the way of the wilderness, but the battle followed hard after them; and those who came out of the cities destroyed them in the middle of it.
43 They surrounded the Benjamites, chased them, and trod them down at their resting place, as far as near Gibeah toward the sunrise.
44 Eighteen thousand men of Benjamin fell; all these were men of valor.
45 They turned and fled toward the wilderness to the rock of Rimmon. They gleaned five thousand men of them in the highways, and followed hard after them to Gidom, and struck two thousand men of them.
46 So that all who fell that day of Benjamin were twenty-five thousand men who drew the sword. All these were men of valor.
47 But six hundred men turned and fled toward the wilderness to the rock of Rimmon, and stayed in the rock of Rimmon four months.
48 The men of Israel turned again on the children of Benjamin, and struck them with the edge of the sword—including the entire city, the livestock, and all that they found. Moreover they set all the cities which they found on fire.

21

1 Now the men of Israel had sworn in

Mizpah, saying, “None of us will give his daughter to Benjamin as a wife.”

2 The people came to Bethel and sat there until evening before God, and lifted up their voices, and wept severely.

3 They said, “Yahweh, the God of Israel, why has this happened in Israel, that there should be one tribe lacking in Israel today?”

4 On the next day, the people rose early and built an altar there, and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings.

5 The children of Israel said, “Who is there among all the tribes of Israel who didn’t come up in the assembly to Yahweh?” For they had made a great oath concerning him who didn’t come up to Yahweh to Mizpah, saying, “He shall surely be put to death.”

6 The children of Israel grieved for Benjamin their brother, and said, “There is one tribe cut off from Israel today.

7 How shall we provide wives for those who remain, since we have sworn by Yahweh that we will not give them of our daughters to wives?”

8 They said, “What one is there of the tribes of Israel who didn’t come up to Yahweh to Mizpah?” Behold, no one came from Jabesh Gilead to the camp to the assembly.

9 For when the people were counted, behold, there were none of the inhabitants of Jabesh Gilead there.

10 The congregation sent twelve thousand of the most valiant men there, and commanded them, saying, “Go and strike the inhabitants of Jabesh Gilead with the edge of the sword, with the women and the little ones.

11 This is the thing that you shall do: you shall utterly destroy every male, and every woman who has lain with a man.”

12 They found among the inhabitants of Jabesh Gilead four hundred young virgins who had not known man by lying with him; and they brought them to the camp to Shiloh, which is in the land of Canaan.

13 The whole congregation sent and spoke to the children of Benjamin who were in the rock of Rimmon, and proclaimed peace to them.

14 Benjamin returned at that time; and they gave them the women whom they had saved alive of the women of Jabesh Gilead. There still weren’t enough for them.

15 The people grieved for Benjamin, because Yahweh had made a breach in the tribes of Israel.

16 Then the elders of the congregation said, “How shall we provide wives for those who remain, since the women are destroyed out of Benjamin?”

17 They said, “There must be an inheritance for those who are escaped of Benjamin, that a tribe not be blotted out from Israel.

18 However, we may not give them wives of our daughters, for the children of Israel had sworn, saying, ‘Cursed is he who gives a wife to Benjamin.’ ”

19 They said, “Behold, there is a feast of Yahweh from year to year in Shiloh, which is on the north of Bethel, on the east side of the highway that goes up from Bethel to Shechem, and on the south of Lebonah.”

20 They commanded the children of Benjamin, saying, “Go and lie in wait in the vineyards,

21 and see, and behold, if the daughters of Shiloh come out to dance in the dances, then come out of the vineyards, and each man catch his wife of the daughters of Shiloh, and go to the land of Benjamin.

22 It shall be, when their fathers or their brothers come to complain to us, that we will say to them, ‘Grant them graciously to us, because we didn’t take for each man his wife in battle, neither did you give them to them; otherwise you would now be guilty.’ ”

23 The children of Benjamin did so, and took wives for themselves according to their number, of those who danced, whom they carried off. They went and returned to their inheritance, built the cities, and lived in them.

24 The children of Israel departed from there at that time, every man to his tribe

and to his family, and they each went out
from there to his own inheritance.
25 In those days there was no king in
Israel. Everyone did that which was right
in his own eyes.

The Book of Ruth

1 In the days when the judges judged,
there was a famine in the land. A certain
man of Bethlehem Judah went to live in
the country of Moab with his wife and his
two sons.
2 The name of the man was Elimelech,
and the name of his wife Naomi. The
names of his two sons were Mahlon and
Chilion, Ephrathites of Bethlehem Judah.
They came into the country of Moab and
lived there.
3 Elimelech, Naomi's husband, died; and
she was left with her two sons.
4 They took for themselves wives of the
women of Moab. The name of the one was
Orpah, and the name of the other was
Ruth. They lived there about ten years.
5 Mahlon and Chilion both died, and the
woman was bereaved of her two children
and of her husband.
6 Then she arose with her
daughters-in-law, that she might return
from the country of Moab; for she had
heard in the country of Moab how
Yahweh† had visited his people in giving
them bread.
7 She went out of the place where she
was, and her two daughters-in-law with
her. They went on the way to return to the
land of Judah.
8 Naomi said to her two
daughters-in-law, "Go, return each of you
to her mother's house. May Yahweh deal
kindly with you, as you have dealt with
the dead and with me.
9 May Yahweh grant you that you may
find rest, each of you in the house of her
husband."
Then she kissed them, and they lifted up
their voices, and wept.
10 They said to her, "No, but we will
return with you to your people."
11 Naomi said, "Go back, my daughters.
Why do you want to go with me? Do I still
have sons in my womb, that they may be
your husbands?
12 Go back, my daughters, go your way;
for I am too old to have a husband. If I
should say, 'I have hope,' if I should even
have a husband tonight, and should also
bear sons,
13 would you then wait until they were
grown? Would you then refrain from
having husbands? No, my daughters, for
it grieves me seriously for your sakes, for
Yahweh's hand has gone out against me."
14 They lifted up their voices and wept
again; then Orpah kissed her
mother-in-law, but Ruth stayed with her.
15 She said, "Behold,‡ your sister-in-law
has gone back to her people and to her
god. Follow your sister-in-law."
16 Ruth said, "Don't urge me to leave
you, and to return from following you, for
where you go, I will go; and where you
stay, I will stay. Your people will be my
people, and your God§ my God.
17 Where you die, I will die, and there I
will be buried. May Yahweh do so to me,
and more also, if anything but death parts
you and me."
18 When Naomi saw that she was
determined to go with her, she stopped
urging her.
19 So they both went until they came to
Bethlehem. When they had come to
Bethlehem, all the city was excited about
them, and they asked, "Is this Naomi?"
20 She said to them, "Don't call me
Naomi.† Call me Mara,‡ for the Almighty
has dealt very bitterly with me.
21 I went out full, and Yahweh has
brought me home again empty. Why do
you call me Naomi, since Yahweh has
testified against me, and the Almighty has
afflicted me?"
22 So Naomi returned, and Ruth the
Moabitess, her daughter-in-law, with her,
who returned out of the country of Moab.
They came to Bethlehem in the beginning
of barley harvest.

† **1:6** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:15** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. § **1:16** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). † **1:20** "Naomi" means "pleasant". ‡ **1:20** "Mara" means "bitter".

2

1 Naomi had a relative of her husband's,
a mighty man of wealth, of the family of
Elimelech, and his name was Boaz.
2 Ruth the Moabitess said to Naomi, "Let
me now go to the field, and glean among
the ears of grain after him in whose sight I
find favor."
She said to her, "Go, my daughter."
3 She went, and came and gleaned in the
field after the reapers; and she happened
to come to the portion of the field
belonging to Boaz, who was of the family
of Elimelech.
4 Behold, Boaz came from Bethlehem,
and said to the reapers, "May Yahweh be
with you."
They answered him, "May Yahweh bless
you."
5 Then Boaz said to his servant who was
set over the reapers, "Whose young lady is
this?"
6 The servant who was set over the
reapers answered, "It is the Moabite lady
who came back with Naomi out of the
country of Moab.
7 She said, 'Please let me glean and
gather after the reapers among the
sheaves.' So she came, and has continued
even from the morning until now, except
that she rested a little in the house."
8 Then Boaz said to Ruth, "Listen, my
daughter. Don't go to glean in another
field, and don't go from here, but stay
here close to my maidens.
9 Let your eyes be on the field that they
reap, and go after them. Haven't I
commanded the young men not to touch
you? When you are thirsty, go to the
vessels, and drink from that which the
young men have drawn."
10 Then she fell on her face and bowed
herself to the ground, and said to him,
"Why have I found favor in your sight,
that you should take knowledge of me,
since I am a foreigner?"
11 Boaz answered her, "I have been told
all about what you have done for your
mother-in-law since the death of your
husband, and how you have left your
father, your mother, and the land of your
birth, and have come to a people that you
didn't know before.
12 May Yahweh repay your work, and a
full reward be given to you from Yahweh,
the God of Israel, under whose wings you
have come to take refuge."
13 Then she said, "Let me find favor in
your sight, my lord, because you have
comforted me, and because you have
spoken kindly to your servant, though I
am not as one of your servants."
14 At meal time Boaz said to her, "Come
here, and eat some bread, and dip your
morsel in the vinegar."
She sat beside the reapers, and they
passed her parched grain. She ate, was
satisfied, and left some of it.
15 When she had risen up to glean, Boaz
commanded his young men, saying, "Let
her glean even among the sheaves, and
don't reproach her.
16 Also pull out some for her from the
bundles, and leave it. Let her glean, and
don't rebuke her."
17 So she gleaned in the field until
evening; and she beat out that which she
had gleaned, and it was about an ephah† of barley.
18 She took it up, and went into the city.
Then her mother-in-law saw what she
had gleaned; and she brought out and
gave to her that which she had left after
she had enough.
19 Her mother-in-law said to her,
"Where have you gleaned today? Where
have you worked? Blessed be he who
noticed you."
She told her mother-in-law with whom
she had worked, "The man's name with
whom I worked today is Boaz."
20 Naomi said to her daughter-in-law,
"May he be blessed by Yahweh, who has
not abandoned his kindness to the living
and to the dead." Naomi said to her, "The
man is a close relative to us, one of our
near kinsmen."
21 Ruth the Moabitess said, "Yes, he said
to me, 'You shall stay close to my young
men until they have finished all my
harvest.' "

† **2:17** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

22 Naomi said to Ruth her
daughter-in-law, “It is good, my daughter,
that you go out with his maidens, and that
they not harm you in any other field.”
23 So she stayed close to the maidens of
Boaz, to glean to the end of barley harvest
and of wheat harvest; and she lived with
her mother-in-law.

3

1 Naomi her mother-in-law said to her,
“My daughter, shall I not seek rest for you,
that it may be well with you?
2 Now isn’t Boaz our kinsman, with
whose maidens you were? Behold, he will
be winnowing barley tonight on the
threshing floor.
3 Therefore wash yourself, anoint
yourself, get dressed, and go down to the
threshing floor; but don’t make yourself
known to the man until he has finished
eating and drinking.
4 It shall be, when he lies down, that you
shall note the place where he is lying.
Then you shall go in, uncover his feet, and
lie down. Then he will tell you what to do.”
5 She said to her, “All that you say, I will
do.”
6 She went down to the threshing floor,
and did everything that her
mother-in-law told her.
7 When Boaz had eaten and drunk, and
his heart was merry, he went to lie down
at the end of the heap of grain. She came
softly, uncovered his feet, and lay down.
8 At midnight, the man was startled and
turned himself; and behold, a woman lay
at his feet.
9 He said, “Who are you?”
She answered, “I am Ruth your servant.
Therefore spread the corner of your
garment over your servant; for you are a
near kinsman.”
10 He said, “You are blessed by Yahweh,
my daughter. You have shown more
kindness in the latter end than at the
beginning, because you didn’t follow
young men, whether poor or rich.
11 Now, my daughter, don’t be afraid. I
will do to you all that you say; for all the
city of my people knows that you are a
worthy woman.
12 Now it is true that I am a near
kinsman. However, there is a kinsman
nearer than I.
13 Stay this night, and in the morning, if
he will perform for you the part of a
kinsman, good. Let him do the kinsman’s
duty. But if he will not do the duty of a
kinsman for you, then I will do the duty of
a kinsman for you, as Yahweh lives. Lie
down until the morning.”
14 She lay at his feet until the morning,
then she rose up before one could discern
another. For he said, “Let it not be known
that the woman came to the threshing
floor.”
15 He said, “Bring the mantle that is on
you, and hold it.” She held it; and he
measured six measures of barley, and laid
it on her; then he went into the city.
16 When she came to her mother-in-law,
she said, “How did it go, my daughter?”
She told her all that the man had done
for her.
17 She said, “He gave me these six
measures of barley; for he said, ‘Don’t go
empty to your mother-in-law.’ ”
18 Then she said, “Wait, my daughter,
until you know what will happen; for the
man will not rest until he has settled this
today.”

4

1 Now Boaz went up to the gate and sat
down there. Behold, the near kinsman of
whom Boaz spoke came by. Boaz said to
him, “Come over here, friend, and sit
down!” He came over, and sat down.
2 Boaz took ten men of the elders of the
city, and said, “Sit down here,” and they
sat down.
3 He said to the near kinsman, “Naomi,
who has come back out of the country of
Moab, is selling the parcel of land, which
was our brother Elimelech’s.
4 I thought I should tell you, saying, ‘Buy
it before those who sit here, and before
the elders of my people.’ If you will
redeem it, redeem it; but if you will not
redeem it, then tell me, that I may know.
For there is no one to redeem it besides
you; and I am after you.”
He said, “I will redeem it.”

5 Then Boaz said, “On the day you buy
the field from the hand of Naomi, you
must buy it also from Ruth the Moabitess,
the wife of the dead, to raise up the name
of the dead on his inheritance.”
6 The near kinsman said, “I can’t redeem
it for myself, lest I endanger my own
inheritance. Take my right of redemption
for yourself; for I can’t redeem it.”
7 Now this was the custom in former
time in Israel concerning redeeming and
concerning exchanging, to confirm all
things: a man took off his sandal, and
gave it to his neighbor; and this was the
way of formalizing transactions in Israel.
8 So the near kinsman said to Boaz, “Buy
it for yourself,” then he took off his sandal.
9 Boaz said to the elders and to all the
people, “You are witnesses today, that I
have bought all that was Elimelech’s, and
all that was Chilion’s and Mahlon’s, from
the hand of Naomi.
10 Moreover, Ruth the Moabitess, the
wife of Mahlon, I have purchased to be
my wife, to raise up the name of the dead
on his inheritance, that the name of the
dead may not be cut off from among his
brothers and from the gate of his place.
You are witnesses today.”
11 All the people who were in the gate,
and the elders, said, “We are witnesses.
May Yahweh make the woman who has
come into your house like Rachel and like
Leah, which both built the house of Israel;
and treat you worthily in Ephrathah, and
be famous in Bethlehem.
12 Let your house be like the house of
Perez, whom Tamar bore to Judah, of the
offspring† which Yahweh will give you by
this young woman.”
13 So Boaz took Ruth and she became his
wife; and he went in to her, and Yahweh
enabled her to conceive, and she bore a
son.
14 The women said to Naomi, “Blessed
be Yahweh, who has not left you today
without a near kinsman. Let his name be
famous in Israel.
15 He shall be to you a restorer of life
and sustain you in your old age; for your
daughter-in-law, who loves you, who is
better to you than seven sons, has given
birth to him.”
16 Naomi took the child, laid him in her
bosom, and became nurse to him.
17 The women, her neighbors, gave him
a name, saying, “A son is born to Naomi”.
They named him Obed. He is the father of
Jesse, the father of David.
18 Now this is the history of the
generations of Perez: Perez became the
father of Hezron,
19 and Hezron became the father of
Ram, and Ram became the father of
Amminadab,
20 and Amminadab became the father of
Nahshon, and Nahshon became the father
of Salmon,
21 and Salmon became the father of
Boaz, and Boaz became the father of
Obed,
22 and Obed became the father of Jesse,
and Jesse became the father of David.

† **4:12** or, seed

The First Book of Samuel

1 Now there was a certain man of
Ramathaim Zophim, of the hill country of
Ephraim, and his name was Elkanah, the
son of Jeroham, the son of Elihu, the son
of Tohu, the son of Zuph, an Ephraimite.
2 He had two wives. The name of one
was Hannah, and the name of the other
Peninnah. Peninnah had children, but
Hannah had no children.
3 This man went up out of his city from
year to year to worship and to sacrifice to
Yahweh† of Armies in Shiloh. The two
sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, priests
to Yahweh, were there.
4 When the day came that Elkanah
sacrificed, he gave portions to Peninnah
his wife and to all her sons and her
daughters;
5 but he gave a double portion to
Hannah, for he loved Hannah, but
Yahweh had shut up her womb.
6 Her rival provoked her severely, to
irritate her, because Yahweh had shut up
her womb.
7 So year by year, when she went up to
Yahweh's house, her rival provoked her.
Therefore she wept, and didn't eat.
8 Elkanah her husband said to her,
"Hannah, why do you weep? Why don't
you eat? Why is your heart grieved? Am I
not better to you than ten sons?"
9 So Hannah rose up after they had
finished eating and drinking in Shiloh.
Now Eli the priest was sitting on his seat
by the doorpost of Yahweh's temple.
10 She was in bitterness of soul, and
prayed to Yahweh, weeping bitterly.
11 She vowed a vow, and said, "Yahweh
of Armies, if you will indeed look at the
affliction of your servant and remember
me, and not forget your servant, but will
give to your servant a boy, then I will give
him to Yahweh all the days of his life, and
no razor shall come on his head."
12 As she continued praying before
Yahweh, Eli saw her mouth.
13 Now Hannah spoke in her heart. Only
her lips moved, but her voice was not
heard. Therefore Eli thought she was
drunk.
14 Eli said to her, "How long will you be
drunk? Get rid of your wine!"
15 Hannah answered, "No, my lord, I am
a woman of a sorrowful spirit. I have not
been drinking wine or strong drink, but I
poured out my soul before Yahweh.
16 Don't consider your servant a wicked
woman; for I have been speaking out of
the abundance of my complaint and my
provocation."
17 Then Eli answered, "Go in peace; and
may the God‡ of Israel grant your petition
that you have asked of him."
18 She said, "Let your servant find favor
in your sight." So the woman went her
way and ate; and her facial expression
wasn't sad any more.
19 They rose up in the morning early
and worshiped Yahweh, then returned
and came to their house to Ramah. Then
Elkanah knew Hannah his wife; and
Yahweh remembered her.
20 When the time had come, Hannah
conceived, and bore a son; and she named
him Samuel,§ saying, "Because I have
asked him of Yahweh."
21 The man Elkanah, and all his house,
went up to offer to Yahweh the yearly
sacrifice and his vow.
22 But Hannah didn't go up, for she said
to her husband, "Not until the child is
weaned; then I will bring him, that he
may appear before Yahweh, and stay
there forever."
23 Elkanah her husband said to her, "Do
what seems good to you. Wait until you
have weaned him; only may Yahweh
establish his word."
So the woman waited and nursed her
son until she weaned him.
24 When she had weaned him, she took
him up with her, with three bulls, and one
ephah† of meal, and a container of wine,

† **1:3** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:17** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). § **1:20** Samuel sounds like the Hebrew for "heard by God."
† **1:24** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

and brought him to Yahweh's house in Shiloh. The child was young.
25 They killed the bull, and brought the child to Eli.
26 She said, "Oh, my lord, as your soul lives, my lord, I am the woman who stood by you here, praying to Yahweh.
27 I prayed for this child, and Yahweh has given me my petition which I asked of him.
28 Therefore I have also given him to Yahweh. As long as he lives he is given to Yahweh." He worshiped Yahweh there.

2

1 Hannah prayed, and said,
"My heart exults in Yahweh!
My horn is exalted in Yahweh.
My mouth is enlarged over my enemies,
because I rejoice in your salvation.
2 There is no one as holy as Yahweh,
for there is no one besides you,
nor is there any rock like our God.

3 "Don't keep talking so exceedingly proudly.
Don't let arrogance come out of your mouth,
for Yahweh is a God of knowledge.
By him actions are weighed.

4 "The bows of the mighty men are broken.
Those who stumbled are armed with strength.
5 Those who were full have hired themselves out for bread.
Those who were hungry are satisfied.
Yes, the barren has borne seven.
She who has many children languishes.

6 "Yahweh kills and makes alive.
He brings down to Sheol† and brings up.
7 Yahweh makes poor and makes rich.
He brings low, he also lifts up.
8 He raises up the poor out of the dust.
He lifts up the needy from the dunghill
to make them sit with princes
and inherit the throne of glory.
For the pillars of the earth are Yahweh's.
He has set the world on them.
9 He will keep the feet of his holy ones,
but the wicked will be put to silence in darkness;
for no man will prevail by strength.
10 Those who strive with Yahweh shall be broken to pieces.
He will thunder against them in the sky.

"Yahweh will judge the ends of the earth.
He will give strength to his king,
and exalt the horn of his anointed."
11 Elkanah went to Ramah to his house. The child served Yahweh before Eli the priest.
12 Now the sons of Eli were wicked men. They didn't know Yahweh.
13 The custom of the priests with the people was that when anyone offered a sacrifice, the priest's servant came while the meat was boiling, with a fork of three teeth in his hand;
14 and he stabbed it into the pan, or kettle, or cauldron, or pot. The priest took all that the fork brought up for himself. They did this to all the Israelites who came there to Shiloh.
15 Yes, before they burned the fat, the priest's servant came, and said to the man who sacrificed, "Give meat to roast for the priest; for he will not accept boiled meat from you, but raw."
16 If the man said to him, "Let the fat be burned first, and then take as much as your soul desires;" then he would say, "No, but you shall give it to me now; and if not, I will take it by force."
17 The sin of the young men was very great before Yahweh; for the men despised Yahweh's offering.
18 But Samuel ministered before Yahweh, being a child, clothed with a linen ephod.
19 Moreover his mother made him a little robe, and brought it to him from year to year when she came up with her husband to offer the yearly sacrifice.
20 Eli blessed Elkanah and his wife, and said, "May Yahweh give you offspring‡

† **2:6** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **2:20** or, seed

from this woman for the petition which was asked of Yahweh." Then they went to their own home.
21 Yahweh visited Hannah, and she conceived and bore three sons and two daughters. The child Samuel grew before Yahweh.
22 Now Eli was very old; and he heard all that his sons did to all Israel, and how that they slept with the women who served at the door of the Tent of Meeting.
23 He said to them, "Why do you do such things? For I hear of your evil dealings from all these people.
24 No, my sons; for it is not a good report that I hear! You make Yahweh's people disobey.
25 If one man sins against another, God will judge him; but if a man sins against Yahweh, who will intercede for him?" Notwithstanding, they didn't listen to the voice of their father, because Yahweh intended to kill them.
26 The child Samuel grew on, and increased in favor both with Yahweh and also with men.
27 A man of God came to Eli and said to him, "Yahweh says, 'Did I reveal myself to the house of your father when they were in Egypt in bondage to Pharaoh's house?
28 Didn't I choose him out of all the tribes of Israel to be my priest, to go up to my altar, to burn incense, to wear an ephod before me? Didn't I give to the house of your father all the offerings of the children of Israel made by fire?
29 Why do you kick at my sacrifice and at my offering, which I have commanded in my habitation, and honor your sons above me, to make yourselves fat with the best of all the offerings of Israel my people?'
30 "Therefore Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, 'I said indeed that your house and the house of your father should walk before me forever.' But now Yahweh says, 'Far be it from me; for those who honor me I will honor, and those who despise me will be cursed.
31 Behold,§ the days come that I will cut off your arm and the arm of your father's house, that there will not be an old man in your house.
32 You will see the affliction of my habitation, in all the wealth which I will give Israel. There shall not be an old man in your house forever.
33 The man of yours whom I don't cut off from my altar will consume your eyes† and grieve your heart. All the increase of your house will die in the flower of their age.
34 This will be the sign to you that will come on your two sons, on Hophni and Phinehas: in one day they will both die.
35 I will raise up a faithful priest for myself who will do according to that which is in my heart and in my mind. I will build him a sure house. He will walk before my anointed forever.
36 It will happen that everyone who is left in your house will come and bow down to him for a piece of silver and a loaf of bread, and will say, "Please put me into one of the priests' offices, that I may eat a morsel of bread." ' "

3

1 The child Samuel ministered to Yahweh before Eli. Yahweh's word was rare in those days. There were not many visions, then.
2 At that time, when Eli was laid down in his place (now his eyes had begun to grow dim, so that he could not see),
3 and God's lamp hadn't yet gone out, and Samuel had laid down in Yahweh's temple where God's ark was,
4 Yahweh called Samuel. He said, "Here I am."
5 He ran to Eli and said, "Here I am; for you called me."

He said, "I didn't call. Lie down again."

He went and lay down.
6 Yahweh called yet again, "Samuel!"

Samuel arose and went to Eli and said, "Here I am; for you called me."

He answered, "I didn't call, my son. Lie down again."

§ **2:31** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
† **2:33** or, blind your eyes with tears

7 Now Samuel didn't yet know Yahweh,
neither was Yahweh's word yet revealed
to him.
8 Yahweh called Samuel again the third
time. He arose and went to Eli and said,
"Here I am; for you called me."

Eli perceived that Yahweh had called
the child.
9 Therefore Eli said to Samuel, "Go, lie
down. It shall be, if he calls you, that you
shall say, 'Speak, Yahweh; for your
servant hears.' " So Samuel went and lay
down in his place.
10 Yahweh came, and stood, and called
as at other times, "Samuel! Samuel!"

Then Samuel said, "Speak; for your
servant hears."
11 Yahweh said to Samuel, "Behold, I
will do a thing in Israel at which both the
ears of everyone who hears it will tingle.
12 In that day I will perform against Eli
all that I have spoken concerning his
house, from the beginning even to the
end.
13 For I have told him that I will judge
his house forever for the iniquity which
he knew, because his sons brought a curse
on themselves, and he didn't restrain
them.
14 Therefore I have sworn to the house
of Eli that the iniquity of Eli's house shall
not be removed with sacrifice or offering
forever."
15 Samuel lay until the morning, and
opened the doors of Yahweh's house.
Samuel was afraid to show Eli the vision.
16 Then Eli called Samuel and said,
"Samuel, my son!"

He said, "Here I am."
17 He said, "What is the thing that he has
spoken to you? Please don't hide it from
me. God do so to you, and more also, if
you hide anything from me of all the
things that he spoke to you."
18 Samuel told him every bit, and hid
nothing from him.

He said, "It is Yahweh. Let him do what
seems good to him."
19 Samuel grew, and Yahweh was with
him and let none of his words fall to the
ground.
20 All Israel from Dan even to Beersheba
knew that Samuel was established to be a
prophet of Yahweh.
21 Yahweh appeared again in Shiloh; for
Yahweh revealed himself to Samuel in
Shiloh by Yahweh's word.

4

1 The word of Samuel came to all Israel.

Now Israel went out against the
Philistines to battle, and encamped beside
Ebenezer; and the Philistines encamped
in Aphek.
2 The Philistines put themselves in array
against Israel. When they joined battle,
Israel was defeated by the Philistines, who
killed about four thousand men of the
army in the field.
3 When the people had come into the
camp, the elders of Israel said, "Why has
Yahweh defeated us today before the
Philistines? Let's get the ark of Yahweh's
covenant out of Shiloh and bring it to us,
that it may come among us and save us
out of the hand of our enemies."
4 So the people sent to Shiloh, and they
brought from there the ark of the
covenant of Yahweh of Armies, who sits
above the cherubim; and the two sons of
Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were there
with the ark of the covenant of God.
5 When the ark of Yahweh's covenant
came into the camp, all Israel shouted
with a great shout, so that the earth
resounded.
6 When the Philistines heard the noise
of the shout, they said, "What does the
noise of this great shout in the camp of the
Hebrews mean?" They understood that
Yahweh's ark had come into the camp.
7 The Philistines were afraid, for they
said, "God has come into the camp." They
said, "Woe to us! For there has not been
such a thing before.
8 Woe to us! Who shall deliver us out of
the hand of these mighty gods? These are
the gods that struck the Egyptians with all
kinds of plagues in the wilderness.
9 Be strong and behave like men, O you
Philistines, that you not be servants to the
Hebrews, as they have been to you.

Strengthen yourselves like men, and fight!”
10 The Philistines fought, and Israel was defeated, and each man fled to his tent. There was a very great slaughter; for thirty thousand footmen of Israel fell.
11 God’s ark was taken; and the two sons of Eli, Hophni and Phinehas, were slain.
12 A man of Benjamin ran out of the army and came to Shiloh the same day, with his clothes torn and with dirt on his head.
13 When he came, behold, Eli was sitting on his seat by the road watching, for his heart trembled for God’s ark. When the man came into the city and told about it, all the city cried out.
14 When Eli heard the noise of the crying, he said, “What does the noise of this tumult mean?”
The man hurried, and came and told Eli.
15 Now Eli was ninety-eight years old. His eyes were set, so that he could not see.
16 The man said to Eli, “I am he who came out of the army, and I fled today out of the army.”
He said, “How did the matter go, my son?”
17 He who brought the news answered, “Israel has fled before the Philistines, and there has been also a great slaughter among the people. Your two sons also, Hophni and Phinehas, are dead, and God’s ark has been captured.”
18 When he made mention of God’s ark, Eli fell from off his seat backward by the side of the gate; and his neck broke, and he died, for he was an old man and heavy. He had judged Israel forty years.
19 His daughter-in-law, Phinehas’ wife, was with child, near to giving birth. When she heard the news that God’s ark was taken and that her father-in-law and her husband were dead, she bowed herself and gave birth; for her pains came on her.
20 About the time of her death the women who stood by her said to her, “Don’t be afraid, for you have given birth to a son.” But she didn’t answer, neither did she regard it.
21 She named the child Ichabod,† saying, “The glory has departed from Israel!” because God’s ark was taken, and because of her father-in-law and her husband.
22 She said, “The glory has departed from Israel; for God’s ark has been taken.”

5

1 Now the Philistines had taken God’s ark, and they brought it from Ebenezer to Ashdod.
2 The Philistines took God’s ark, and brought it into the house of Dagon and set it by Dagon.
3 When the people of Ashdod arose early on the next day, behold, Dagon had fallen on his face to the ground before Yahweh’s ark. They took Dagon and set him in his place again.
4 When they arose early on the following morning, behold, Dagon had fallen on his face to the ground before Yahweh’s ark; and the head of Dagon and both the palms of his hands were cut off on the threshold. Only Dagon’s torso was intact.
5 Therefore neither the priests of Dagon nor any who come into Dagon’s house step on the threshold of Dagon in Ashdod to this day.
6 But Yahweh’s hand was heavy on the people of Ashdod, and he destroyed them and struck them with tumors, even Ashdod and its borders.
7 When the men of Ashdod saw that it was so, they said, “The ark of the God of Israel shall not stay with us, for his hand is severe on us and on Dagon our god.”
8 They sent therefore and gathered together all the lords of the Philistines, and said, “What shall we do with the ark of the God of Israel?”
They answered, “Let the ark of the God of Israel be carried over to Gath.” They carried the ark of the God of Israel there.
9 It was so, that after they had carried it there, Yahweh’s hand was against the city with a very great confusion; and he struck the men of the city, both small and great, so that tumors broke out on them.
10 So they sent God’s ark to Ekron.

† **4:21** “Ichabod” means “no glory”.

As God's ark came to Ekron, the
Ekronites cried out, saying, "They have
brought the ark of the God of Israel here
to us, to kill us and our people."
11 They sent therefore and gathered
together all the lords of the Philistines,
and they said, "Send the ark of the God of
Israel away, and let it go again to its own
place, that it not kill us and our people."
For there was a deadly panic throughout
all the city. The hand of God was very
heavy there.
12 The men who didn't die were struck
with the tumors; and the cry of the city
went up to heaven.

6

1 Yahweh's ark was in the country of the
Philistines seven months.
2 The Philistines called for the priests
and the diviners, saying, "What shall we
do with Yahweh's ark? Show us how we
should send it to its place."

3 They said, "If you send away the ark of
the God of Israel, don't send it empty; but
by all means return a trespass offering to
him. Then you will be healed, and it will
be known to you why his hand is not
removed from you."

4 Then they said, "What should the
trespass offering be which we shall return
to him?"

They said, "Five golden tumors and five
golden mice, for the number of the lords
of the Philistines; for one plague was on
you all, and on your lords.
5 Therefore you shall make images of
your tumors and images of your mice that
mar the land; and you shall give glory to
the God of Israel. Perhaps he will release
his hand from you, from your gods, and
from your land.
6 Why then do you harden your hearts
as the Egyptians and Pharaoh hardened
their hearts? When he had worked
wonderfully among them, didn't they let
the people go, and they departed?

7 "Now therefore take and prepare
yourselves a new cart and two milk cows
on which there has come no yoke; and tie
the cows to the cart, and bring their calves
home from them;
8 and take Yahweh's ark and lay it on the
cart. Put the jewels of gold, which you
return him for a trespass offering, in a
box by its side; and send it away, that it
may go.
9 Behold, if it goes up by the way of its
own border to Beth Shemesh, then he has
done us this great evil; but if not, then we
shall know that it is not his hand that
struck us. It was a chance that happened
to us."
10 The men did so, and took two milk
cows and tied them to the cart, and shut
up their calves at home.
11 They put Yahweh's ark on the cart,
and the box with the golden mice and the
images of their tumors.
12 The cows took the straight way by the
way to Beth Shemesh. They went along
the highway, lowing as they went, and
didn't turn away to the right hand or to
the left; and the lords of the Philistines
went after them to the border of Beth
Shemesh.
13 The people of Beth Shemesh were
reaping their wheat harvest in the valley;
and they lifted up their eyes and saw the
ark, and rejoiced to see it.
14 The cart came into the field of Joshua
of Beth Shemesh, and stood there, where
there was a great stone. Then they split
the wood of the cart and offered up the
cows for a burnt offering to Yahweh.
15 The Levites took down Yahweh's ark
and the box that was with it, in which the
jewels of gold were, and put them on the
great stone; and the men of Beth Shemesh
offered burnt offerings and sacrificed
sacrifices the same day to Yahweh.
16 When the five lords of the Philistines
had seen it, they returned to Ekron the
same day.
17 These are the golden tumors which
the Philistines returned for a trespass
offering to Yahweh: for Ashdod one, for
Gaza one, for Ashkelon one, for Gath one,
for Ekron one;
18 and the golden mice, according to the
number of all the cities of the Philistines
belonging to the five lords, both of

fortified cities and of country villages, even to the great stone on which they set down Yahweh's ark. That stone remains to this day in the field of Joshua of Beth Shemesh.
19 He struck of the men of Beth Shemesh, because they had looked into Yahweh's ark, he struck fifty thousand seventy of the men. Then the people mourned, because Yahweh had struck the people with a great slaughter.
20 The men of Beth Shemesh said, "Who is able to stand before Yahweh, this holy God? To whom shall he go up from us?"
21 They sent messengers to the inhabitants of Kiriath Jearim, saying, "The Philistines have brought back Yahweh's ark. Come down and bring it up to yourselves."

7

1 The men of Kiriath Jearim came and took Yahweh's ark, and brought it into Abinadab's house on the hill, and consecrated Eleazar his son to keep Yahweh's ark.
2 From the day that the ark stayed in Kiriath Jearim, the time was long—for it was twenty years; and all the house of Israel lamented after Yahweh.
3 Samuel spoke to all the house of Israel, saying, "If you are returning to Yahweh with all your heart, then put away the foreign gods and the Ashtaroth from among you, and direct your hearts to Yahweh, and serve him only; and he will deliver you out of the hand of the Philistines."
4 Then the children of Israel removed the Baals and the Ashtaroth, and served Yahweh only.
5 Samuel said, "Gather all Israel to Mizpah, and I will pray to Yahweh for you."
6 They gathered together to Mizpah, and drew water, and poured it out before Yahweh, and fasted on that day, and said there, "We have sinned against Yahweh." Samuel judged the children of Israel in Mizpah.
7 When the Philistines heard that the children of Israel were gathered together at Mizpah, the lords of the Philistines went up against Israel. When the children of Israel heard it, they were afraid of the Philistines.
8 The children of Israel said to Samuel, "Don't stop crying to Yahweh our God for us, that he will save us out of the hand of the Philistines."
9 Samuel took a suckling lamb, and offered it for a whole burnt offering to Yahweh. Samuel cried to Yahweh for Israel, and Yahweh answered him.
10 As Samuel was offering up the burnt offering, the Philistines came near to battle against Israel; but Yahweh thundered with a great thunder on that day on the Philistines and confused them; and they were struck down before Israel.
11 The men of Israel went out of Mizpah and pursued the Philistines, and struck them until they came under Beth Kar.
12 Then Samuel took a stone and set it between Mizpah and Shen, and called its name Ebenezer,† saying, "Yahweh helped us until now."
13 So the Philistines were subdued, and they stopped coming within the border of Israel. Yahweh's hand was against the Philistines all the days of Samuel.
14 The cities which the Philistines had taken from Israel were restored to Israel, from Ekron even to Gath; and Israel recovered its border out of the hand of the Philistines. There was peace between Israel and the Amorites.
15 Samuel judged Israel all the days of his life.
16 He went from year to year in a circuit to Bethel, Gilgal, and Mizpah; and he judged Israel in all those places.
17 His return was to Ramah, for his house was there, and he judged Israel there; and he built an altar to Yahweh there.

8

1 When Samuel was old, he made his sons judges over Israel.

† **7:12** "Ebenezer" means "stone of help".

2 Now the name of his firstborn was
Joel, and the name of his second, Abijah.
They were judges in Beersheba.
3 His sons didn't walk in his ways, but
turned away after dishonest gain, took
bribes, and perverted justice.
4 Then all the elders of Israel gathered
themselves together and came to Samuel
to Ramah.
5 They said to him, "Behold, you are old,
and your sons don't walk in your ways.
Now make us a king to judge us like all the
nations."
6 But the thing displeased Samuel when
they said, "Give us a king to judge us."
Samuel prayed to Yahweh.
7 Yahweh said to Samuel, "Listen to the
voice of the people in all that they tell you;
for they have not rejected you, but they
have rejected me as the king over them.
8 According to all the works which they
have done since the day that I brought
them up out of Egypt even to this day, in
that they have forsaken me and served
other gods, so they also do to you.
9 Now therefore, listen to their voice.
However, you shall protest solemnly to
them, and shall show them the way of the
king who will reign over them."
10 Samuel told all Yahweh's words to the
people who asked him for a king.
11 He said, "This will be the way of the
king who shall reign over you: he will
take your sons and appoint them as his
servants, for his chariots and to be his
horsemen; and they will run before his
chariots.
12 He will appoint them to him for
captains of thousands and captains of
fifties; and he will assign some to plow his
ground and to reap his harvest; and to
make his instruments of war and the
instruments of his chariots.
13 He will take your daughters to be
perfumers, to be cooks, and to be bakers.
14 He will take your fields, your
vineyards, and your olive groves, even
your best, and give them to his servants.
15 He will take one tenth of your seed
and of your vineyards, and give it to his
officers and to his servants.
16 He will take your male servants, your
female servants, your best young men,
and your donkeys, and assign them to his
own work.
17 He will take one tenth of your flocks;
and you will be his servants.
18 You will cry out in that day because of
your king whom you will have chosen for
yourselves; and Yahweh will not answer
you in that day."
19 But the people refused to listen to the
voice of Samuel; and they said, "No, but
we will have a king over us,
20 that we also may be like all the
nations; and that our king may judge us,
and go out before us, and fight our
battles."
21 Samuel heard all the words of the
people, and he rehearsed them in the ears
of Yahweh.
22 Yahweh said to Samuel, "Listen to
their voice, and make them a king."
Samuel said to the men of Israel,
"Everyone go to your own city."

9

1 Now there was a man of Benjamin,
whose name was Kish the son of Abiel, the
son of Zeror, the son of Becorath, the son
of Aphiah, the son of a Benjamite, a
mighty man of valor.
2 He had a son whose name was Saul, an
impressive young man; and there was not
among the children of Israel a more
handsome person than he. From his
shoulders and upward he was taller than
any of the people.
3 The donkeys of Kish, Saul's father,
were lost. Kish said to Saul his son, "Now
take one of the servants with you, and
arise, go look for the donkeys."
4 He passed through the hill country of
Ephraim, and passed through the land of
Shalishah, but they didn't find them. Then
they passed through the land of Shaalim,
and they weren't there. Then he passed
through the land of the Benjamites, but
they didn't find them.
5 When they had come to the land of
Zuph, Saul said to his servant who was
with him, "Come! Let's return, lest my

father stop caring about the donkeys and be anxious for us."
6 The servant said to him, "Behold now, there is a man of God in this city, and he is a man who is held in honor. All that he says surely happens. Now let's go there. Perhaps he can tell us which way to go."
7 Then Saul said to his servant, "But behold, if we go, what should we bring the man? For the bread is spent in our sacks, and there is not a present to bring to the man of God. What do we have?"
8 The servant answered Saul again and said, "Behold, I have in my hand the fourth part of a shekel† of silver. I will give that to the man of God, to tell us our way."
9 (In earlier times in Israel, when a man went to inquire of God, he said, "Come! Let's go to the seer;" for he who is now called a prophet was before called a seer.)
10 Then Saul said to his servant, "Well said. Come! Let's go." So they went to the city where the man of God was.
11 As they went up the ascent to the city, they found young maidens going out to draw water, and said to them, "Is the seer here?"
12 They answered them and said, "He is. Behold, he is before you. Hurry now, for he has come today into the city; for the people have a sacrifice today in the high place.
13 As soon as you have come into the city, you will immediately find him before he goes up to the high place to eat; for the people will not eat until he comes, because he blesses the sacrifice. Afterwards those who are invited eat. Now therefore go up; for at this time you will find him."
14 They went up to the city. As they came within the city, behold, Samuel came out toward them to go up to the high place.
15 Now Yahweh had revealed to Samuel a day before Saul came, saying,
16 "Tomorrow about this time I will send you a man out of the land of Benjamin, and you shall anoint him to be prince over my people Israel. He will save my people out of the hand of the Philistines; for I have looked upon my people, because their cry has come to me."
17 When Samuel saw Saul, Yahweh said to him, "Behold, the man of whom I spoke to you! He will have authority over my people."
18 Then Saul approached Samuel in the gateway, and said, "Please tell me where the seer's house is."
19 Samuel answered Saul and said, "I am the seer. Go up before me to the high place, for you are to eat with me today. In the morning I will let you go and will tell you all that is in your heart.
20 As for your donkeys who were lost three days ago, don't set your mind on them, for they have been found. For whom does all Israel desire? Is it not you and all your father's house?"
21 Saul answered, "Am I not a Benjamite, of the smallest of the tribes of Israel? And my family the least of all the families of the tribe of Benjamin? Why then do you speak to me like this?"
22 Samuel took Saul and his servant and brought them into the guest room, and made them sit in the best place among those who were invited, who were about thirty persons.
23 Samuel said to the cook, "Bring the portion which I gave you, of which I said to you, 'Set it aside.' "
24 The cook took up the thigh, and that which was on it, and set it before Saul. Samuel said, "Behold, that which has been reserved! Set it before yourself and eat; because it has been kept for you for the appointed time, for I said, 'I have invited the people.' " So Saul ate with Samuel that day.
25 When they had come down from the high place into the city, he talked with Saul on the housetop.
26 They arose early; and about daybreak, Samuel called to Saul on the housetop, saying, "Get up, that I may send you away." Saul arose, and they both went outside, he and Samuel, together.

† **9:8** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1/4 shekel would be a small coin of about 2.5 grams.

27 As they were going down at the end of the city, Samuel said to Saul, “Tell the servant to go on ahead of us.” He went ahead, then Samuel said, “But stand still first, that I may cause you to hear God’s message.”

10

1 Then Samuel took the vial of oil and poured it on his head, then kissed him and said, “Hasn’t Yahweh anointed you to be prince over his inheritance?

2 When you have departed from me today, then you will find two men by Rachel’s tomb, on the border of Benjamin at Zelzah. They will tell you, ‘The donkeys which you went to look for have been found; and behold, your father has stopped caring about the donkeys and is anxious for you, saying, “What shall I do for my son?” ’

3 “Then you will go on forward from there, and you will come to the oak of Tabor. Three men will meet you there going up to God to Bethel: one carrying three young goats, and another carrying three loaves of bread, and another carrying a container of wine.

4 They will greet you and give you two loaves of bread, which you shall receive from their hand.

5 “After that you will come to the hill of God, where the garrison of the Philistines is; and it will happen, when you have come there to the city, that you will meet a band of prophets coming down from the high place with a lute, a tambourine, a pipe, and a harp before them; and they will be prophesying.

6 Then Yahweh’s Spirit will come mightily on you, then you will prophesy with them and will be turned into another man.

7 Let it be, when these signs have come to you, that you do what is appropriate for the occasion; for God is with you.

8 “Go down ahead of me to Gilgal; and behold, I will come down to you to offer burnt offerings and to sacrifice sacrifices of peace offerings. Wait seven days, until I come to you and show you what you are to do.”

9 It was so, that when he had turned his back to go from Samuel, God gave him another heart; and all those signs happened that day.

10 When they came there to the hill, behold, a band of prophets met him; and the Spirit of God came mightily on him, and he prophesied among them.

11 When all who knew him before saw that, behold, he prophesied with the prophets, then the people said to one another, “What is this that has come to the son of Kish? Is Saul also among the prophets?”

12 One from the same place answered, “Who is their father?” Therefore it became a proverb, “Is Saul also among the prophets?”

13 When he had finished prophesying, he came to the high place.

14 Saul’s uncle said to him and to his servant, “Where did you go?”

He said, “To seek the donkeys. When we saw that they were not found, we came to Samuel.”

15 Saul’s uncle said, “Please tell me what Samuel said to you.”

16 Saul said to his uncle, “He told us plainly that the donkeys were found.” But concerning the matter of the kingdom, of which Samuel spoke, he didn’t tell him.

17 Samuel called the people together to Yahweh to Mizpah;

18 and he said to the children of Israel, “Yahweh, the God of Israel, says ‘I brought Israel up out of Egypt and I delivered you out of the hand of the Egyptians, and out of the hand of all the kingdoms that oppressed you.’

19 But you have today rejected your God, who himself saves you out of all your calamities and your distresses; and you have said to him, ‘No! Set a king over us!’ Now therefore present yourselves before Yahweh by your tribes and by your thousands.”

20 So Samuel brought all the tribes of Israel near, and the tribe of Benjamin was chosen.

21 He brought the tribe of Benjamin
near by their families and the family of
the Matrites was chosen. Then Saul the
son of Kish was chosen; but when they
looked for him, he could not be found.
22 Therefore they asked of Yahweh
further, "Is there yet a man to come here?"
Yahweh answered, "Behold, he has
hidden himself among the baggage."
23 They ran and got him there. When he
stood among the people, he was higher
than any of the people from his shoulders
and upward.
24 Samuel said to all the people, "Do you
see him whom Yahweh has chosen, that
there is no one like him among all the
people?"
All the people shouted and said, "Long
live the king!"
25 Then Samuel told the people the
regulations of the kingdom, and wrote it
in a book and laid it up before Yahweh.
Samuel sent all the people away, every
man to his house.
26 Saul also went to his house in Gibeah;
and the army went with him, whose
hearts God had touched.
27 But certain worthless fellows said,
"How could this man save us?" They
despised him, and brought him no tribute.
But he held his peace.

11

1 Then Nahash the Ammonite came up
and encamped against Jabesh Gilead; and
all the men of Jabesh said to Nahash,
"Make a covenant with us, and we will
serve you."
2 Nahash the Ammonite said to them,
"On this condition I will make it with you,
that all your right eyes be gouged out. I
will make this dishonor all Israel."
3 The elders of Jabesh said to him, "Give
us seven days, that we may send
messengers to all the borders of Israel;
and then, if there is no one to save us, we
will come out to you."
4 Then the messengers came to Gibeah
of Saul, and spoke these words in the ears
of the people, then all the people lifted up
their voice and wept.
5 Behold, Saul came following the oxen
out of the field; and Saul said, "What ails
the people that they weep?" They told him
the words of the men of Jabesh.
6 God's Spirit came mightily on Saul
when he heard those words, and his
anger burned hot.
7 He took a yoke of oxen and cut them in
pieces, then sent them throughout all the
borders of Israel by the hand of
messengers, saying, "Whoever doesn't
come out after Saul and after Samuel, so
shall it be done to his oxen." The dread of
Yahweh fell on the people, and they came
out as one man.
8 He counted them in Bezek; and the
children of Israel were three hundred
thousand, and the men of Judah thirty
thousand.
9 They said to the messengers who
came, "Tell the men of Jabesh Gilead,
'Tomorrow, by the time the sun is hot, you
will be rescued.' " The messengers came
and told the men of Jabesh; and they were
glad.
10 Therefore the men of Jabesh said,
"Tomorrow we will come out to you, and
you shall do with us all that seems good to
you."
11 On the next day, Saul put the people
in three companies; and they came into
the middle of the camp in the morning
watch, and struck the Ammonites until
the heat of the day. Those who remained
were scattered, so that no two of them
were left together.
12 The people said to Samuel, "Who is he
who said, 'Shall Saul reign over us?' Bring
those men, that we may put them to
death!"
13 Saul said, "No man shall be put to
death today; for today Yahweh has
rescued Israel."
14 Then Samuel said to the people,
"Come! Let's go to Gilgal, and renew the
kingdom there."
15 All the people went to Gilgal; and
there they made Saul king before Yahweh
in Gilgal. There they offered sacrifices of
peace offerings before Yahweh; and there
Saul and all the men of Israel rejoiced
greatly.

12

1 Samuel said to all Israel, “Behold, I
have listened to your voice in all that you
said to me, and have made a king over
you.
2 Now, behold, the king walks before
you. I am old and gray-headed. Behold,
my sons are with you. I have walked
before you from my youth to this day.
3 Here I am. Witness against me before
Yahweh and before his anointed. Whose
ox have I taken? Whose donkey have I
taken? Whom have I defrauded? Whom
have I oppressed? Of whose hand have I
taken a bribe to make me blind my eyes? I
will restore it to you.”
4 They said, “You have not defrauded us,
nor oppressed us, neither have you taken
anything from anyone’s hand.”
5 He said to them, “Yahweh is witness
against you, and his anointed is witness
today, that you have not found anything
in my hand.”
They said, “He is witness.”
6 Samuel said to the people, “It is
Yahweh who appointed Moses and Aaron,
and that brought your fathers up out of
the land of Egypt.
7 Now therefore stand still, that I may
plead with you before Yahweh concerning
all the righteous acts of Yahweh, which he
did to you and to your fathers.
8 “When Jacob had come into Egypt, and
your fathers cried to Yahweh, then
Yahweh sent Moses and Aaron, who
brought your fathers out of Egypt, and
made them to dwell in this place.
9 But they forgot Yahweh their God; and
he sold them into the hand of Sisera,
captain of the army of Hazor, and into the
hand of the Philistines, and into the hand
of the king of Moab; and they fought
against them.
10 They cried to Yahweh, and said, ‘We
have sinned, because we have forsaken
Yahweh and have served the Baals and
the Ashtaroth; but now deliver us out of
the hand of our enemies, and we will
serve you.’
11 Yahweh sent Jerubbaal, Bedan,
Jephthah, and Samuel, and delivered you
out of the hand of your enemies on every
side; and you lived in safety.
12 “When you saw that Nahash the king
of the children of Ammon came against
you, you said to me, ‘No, but a king shall
reign over us,’ when Yahweh your God
was your king.
13 Now therefore see the king whom you
have chosen and whom you have asked
for. Behold, Yahweh has set a king over
you.
14 If you will fear Yahweh, and serve
him, and listen to his voice, and not rebel
against the commandment of Yahweh,
then both you and also the king who
reigns over you are followers of Yahweh
your God.
15 But if you will not listen to Yahweh’s
voice, but rebel against the
commandment of Yahweh, then Yahweh’s
hand will be against you, as it was against
your fathers.
16 “Now therefore stand still and see this
great thing, which Yahweh will do before
your eyes.
17 Isn’t it wheat harvest today? I will call
to Yahweh, that he may send thunder and
rain; and you will know and see that your
wickedness is great, which you have done
in Yahweh’s sight, in asking for a king.”
18 So Samuel called to Yahweh, and
Yahweh sent thunder and rain that day.
Then all the people greatly feared Yahweh
and Samuel.
19 All the people said to Samuel, “Pray
for your servants to Yahweh your God,
that we not die; for we have added to all
our sins this evil, to ask for a king.”
20 Samuel said to the people, “Don’t be
afraid. You have indeed done all this evil;
yet don’t turn away from following
Yahweh, but serve Yahweh with all your
heart.
21 Don’t turn away to go after vain
things which can’t profit or deliver, for
they are vain.
22 For Yahweh will not forsake his
people for his great name’s sake, because
it has pleased Yahweh to make you a
people for himself.
23 Moreover, as for me, far be it from me
that I should sin against Yahweh in

ceasing to pray for you; but I will instruct you in the good and the right way.
24 Only fear Yahweh, and serve him in truth with all your heart; for consider what great things he has done for you.
25 But if you keep doing evil, you will be consumed, both you and your king."

13

1 Saul was thirty years old when he became king, and he reigned over Israel forty-two years.†
2 Saul chose for himself three thousand men of Israel, of which two thousand were with Saul in Michmash and in the Mount of Bethel, and one thousand were with Jonathan in Gibeah of Benjamin. He sent the rest of the people to their own tents.
3 Jonathan struck the garrison of the Philistines that was in Geba, and the Philistines heard of it. Saul blew the trumpet throughout all the land, saying, "Let the Hebrews hear!"
4 All Israel heard that Saul had struck the garrison of the Philistines, and also that Israel was considered an abomination to the Philistines. The people were gathered together after Saul to Gilgal.
5 The Philistines assembled themselves together to fight with Israel: thirty thousand chariots, six thousand horsemen, and people as the sand which is on the seashore in multitude. They came up and encamped in Michmash, eastward of Beth Aven.
6 When the men of Israel saw that they were in trouble (for the people were distressed), then the people hid themselves in caves, in thickets, in rocks, in tombs, and in pits.
7 Now some of the Hebrews had gone over the Jordan to the land of Gad and Gilead; but as for Saul, he was yet in Gilgal, and all the people followed him trembling.
8 He stayed seven days, according to the time set by Samuel; but Samuel didn't come to Gilgal, and the people were scattering from him.
9 Saul said, "Bring the burnt offering to me here, and the peace offerings." He offered the burnt offering.
10 It came to pass that as soon as he had finished offering the burnt offering, behold, Samuel came; and Saul went out to meet him, that he might greet him.
11 Samuel said, "What have you done?"
Saul said, "Because I saw that the people were scattered from me, and that you didn't come within the days appointed, and that the Philistines assembled themselves together at Michmash,
12 therefore I said, 'Now the Philistines will come down on me to Gilgal, and I haven't entreated the favor of Yahweh.' I forced myself therefore, and offered the burnt offering."
13 Samuel said to Saul, "You have done foolishly. You have not kept the commandment of Yahweh your God, which he commanded you; for now Yahweh would have established your kingdom on Israel forever.
14 But now your kingdom will not continue. Yahweh has sought for himself a man after his own heart, and Yahweh has appointed him to be prince over his people, because you have not kept that which Yahweh commanded you."
15 Samuel arose, and went from Gilgal to Gibeah of Benjamin. Saul counted the people who were present with him, about six hundred men.
16 Saul, and Jonathan his son, and the people who were present with them, stayed in Geba of Benjamin; but the Philistines encamped in Michmash.
17 The raiders came out of the camp of the Philistines in three companies: one company turned to the way that leads to Ophrah, to the land of Shual;
18 another company turned the way to Beth Horon; and another company turned the way of the border that looks down on the valley of Zeboim toward the wilderness.
19 Now there was no blacksmith found throughout all the land of Israel, for the

† **13:1** The traditional Hebrew text omits "thirty" and "forty-". The blanks are filled in here from a few manuscripts of the Septuagint.

Philistines said, “Lest the Hebrews make themselves swords or spears”;
20 but all the Israelites went down to the Philistines, each man to sharpen his own plowshare, mattock, ax, and sickle.
21 The price was one payim‡ each to sharpen mattocks, plowshares, pitchforks, axes, and goads.
22 So it came to pass in the day of battle that neither sword nor spear was found in the hand of any of the people who were with Saul and Jonathan; but Saul and Jonathan his son had them.
23 The garrison of the Philistines went out to the pass of Michmash.

14

1 Now it happened on a day that Jonathan the son of Saul said to the young man who bore his armor, “Come! Let’s go over to the Philistines’ garrison that is on the other side.” But he didn’t tell his father.
2 Saul stayed in the uttermost part of Gibeah under the pomegranate tree which is in Migron; and the people who were with him were about six hundred men,
3 including Ahijah the son of Ahitub, Ichabod’s brother, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eli the priest of Yahweh in Shiloh, wearing an ephod. The people didn’t know that Jonathan was gone.
4 Between the passes, by which Jonathan sought to go over to the Philistines’ garrison, there was a rocky crag on the one side and a rocky crag on the other side; and the name of the one was Bozez, and the name of the other Seneh.
5 The one crag rose up on the north in front of Michmash, and the other on the south in front of Geba.
6 Jonathan said to the young man who bore his armor, “Come! Let’s go over to the garrison of these uncircumcised. It may be that Yahweh will work for us, for there is no restraint on Yahweh to save by many or by few.”
7 His armor bearer said to him, “Do all that is in your heart. Go, and behold, I am with you according to your heart.”
8 Then Jonathan said, “Behold, we will pass over to the men, and we will reveal ourselves to them.
9 If they say this to us, ‘Wait until we come to you!’ then we will stand still in our place and will not go up to them.
10 But if they say this, ‘Come up to us!’ then we will go up, for Yahweh has delivered them into our hand. This shall be the sign to us.”
11 Both of them revealed themselves to the garrison of the Philistines; and the Philistines said, “Behold, the Hebrews are coming out of the holes where they had hidden themselves!”
12 The men of the garrison answered Jonathan and his armor bearer, and said, “Come up to us, and we will show you something!”
Jonathan said to his armor bearer, “Come up after me, for Yahweh has delivered them into the hand of Israel.”
13 Jonathan climbed up on his hands and on his feet, and his armor bearer after him, and they fell before Jonathan; and his armor bearer killed them after him.
14 That first slaughter, which Jonathan and his armor bearer made, was about twenty men, within as it were half a furrow’s length in an acre of land.
15 There was a trembling in the camp, in the field, and among all the people; the garrison and the raiders also trembled; and the earth quaked, so there was an exceedingly great trembling.
16 The watchmen of Saul in Gibeah of Benjamin looked; and behold, the multitude melted away and scattered.
17 Then Saul said to the people who were with him, “Count now, and see who is missing from us.” When they had counted, behold, Jonathan and his armor bearer were not there.
18 Saul said to Ahijah, “Bring God’s ark here.” For God’s ark was with the children of Israel at that time.
19 While Saul talked to the priest, the tumult that was in the camp of the

‡ **13:21** A payim (or pim) was 2/3 shekel of silver, or 0.26 ounces, or 7.6 grams

Philistines went on and increased; and Saul said to the priest, “Withdraw your hand!”

20 Saul and all the people who were with him were gathered together, and came to the battle; and behold, they were all striking each other with their swords in very great confusion.

21 Now the Hebrews who were with the Philistines before and who went up with them into the camp from all around, even they also turned to be with the Israelites who were with Saul and Jonathan.

22 Likewise all the men of Israel who had hidden themselves in the hill country of Ephraim, when they heard that the Philistines fled, even they also followed hard after them in the battle.

23 So Yahweh saved Israel that day; and the battle passed over by Beth Aven.

24 The men of Israel were distressed that day; for Saul had adjured the people, saying, “Cursed is the man who eats any food until it is evening, and I am avenged of my enemies.” So none of the people tasted food.

25 All the people came into the forest; and there was honey on the ground.

26 When the people had come to the forest, behold, honey was dripping, but no one put his hand to his mouth, for the people feared the oath.

27 But Jonathan didn’t hear when his father commanded the people with the oath. Therefore he put out the end of the rod that was in his hand and dipped it in the honeycomb, and put his hand to his mouth; and his eyes brightened.

28 Then one of the people answered, and said, “Your father directly commanded the people with an oath, saying, ‘Cursed is the man who eats food today.’ ” So the people were faint.

29 Then Jonathan said, “My father has troubled the land. Please look how my eyes have brightened because I tasted a little of this honey.

30 How much more, if perhaps the people had eaten freely today of the plunder of their enemies which they found? For now there has been no great slaughter among the Philistines.”

31 They struck the Philistines that day from Michmash to Aijalon. The people were very faint;

32 and the people pounced on the plunder, and took sheep, cattle, and calves, and killed them on the ground; and the people ate them with the blood.

33 Then they told Saul, saying, “Behold, the people are sinning against Yahweh, in that they eat meat with the blood.”

He said, “You have dealt treacherously. Roll a large stone to me today!”

34 Saul said, “Disperse yourselves among the people, and tell them, ‘Every man bring me here his ox, and every man his sheep, and kill them here, and eat; and don’t sin against Yahweh in eating meat with the blood.’ ” All the people brought every man his ox with him that night, and killed them there.

35 Saul built an altar to Yahweh. This was the first altar that he built to Yahweh.

36 Saul said, “Let’s go down after the Philistines by night, and take plunder among them until the morning light. Let’s not leave a man of them.”

They said, “Do whatever seems good to you.”

Then the priest said, “Let’s draw near here to God.”

37 Saul asked counsel of God: “Shall I go down after the Philistines? Will you deliver them into the hand of Israel?” But he didn’t answer him that day.

38 Saul said, “Draw near here, all you chiefs of the people, and know and see in whom this sin has been today.

39 For as Yahweh lives, who saves Israel, though it is in Jonathan my son, he shall surely die.” But there was not a man among all the people who answered him.

40 Then he said to all Israel, “You be on one side, and I and Jonathan my son will be on the other side.”

The people said to Saul, “Do what seems good to you.”

41 Therefore Saul said to Yahweh, the God of Israel, “Show the right.”

Jonathan and Saul were chosen, but the people escaped.

42 Saul said, “Cast lots between me and
Jonathan my son.”
Jonathan was selected.
43 Then Saul said to Jonathan, “Tell me
what you have done!”
Jonathan told him, and said, “I certainly
did taste a little honey with the end of the
rod that was in my hand; and behold, I
must die.”
44 Saul said, “God do so and more also;
for you shall surely die, Jonathan.”
45 The people said to Saul, “Shall
Jonathan die, who has worked this great
salvation in Israel? Far from it! As
Yahweh lives, there shall not one hair of
his head fall to the ground, for he has
worked with God today!” So the people
rescued Jonathan, so he didn’t die.
46 Then Saul went up from following the
Philistines; and the Philistines went to
their own place.
47 Now when Saul had taken the
kingdom over Israel, he fought against all
his enemies on every side: against Moab,
and against the children of Ammon, and
against Edom, and against the kings of
Zobah, and against the Philistines.
Wherever he turned himself, he defeated
them.
48 He did valiantly and struck the
Amalekites, and delivered Israel out of the
hands of those who plundered them.
49 Now the sons of Saul were Jonathan,
Ishvi, and Malchishua; and the names of
his two daughters were these: the name
of the firstborn Merab, and the name of
the younger Michal.
50 The name of Saul’s wife was Ahinoam
the daughter of Ahimaaz. The name of the
captain of his army was Abner the son of
Ner, Saul’s uncle.
51 Kish was the father of Saul, and Ner
the father of Abner was the son of Abiel.
52 There was severe war against the
Philistines all the days of Saul; and when
Saul saw any mighty man or any valiant
man, he took him into his service.

15

1 Samuel said to Saul, “Yahweh sent me
to anoint you to be king over his people,
over Israel. Now therefore listen to the
voice of Yahweh’s words.

2 Yahweh of Armies says, ‘I remember
what Amalek did to Israel, how he set
himself against him on the way when he
came up out of Egypt.
3 Now go and strike Amalek, and utterly
destroy all that they have, and don’t spare
them; but kill both man and woman,
infant and nursing baby, ox and sheep,
camel and donkey.’ ”

4 Saul summoned the people, and
counted them in Telaim, two hundred
thousand footmen and ten thousand men
of Judah.
5 Saul came to the city of Amalek, and
set an ambush in the valley.
6 Saul said to the Kenites, “Go, depart, go
down from among the Amalekites, lest I
destroy you with them; for you showed
kindness to all the children of Israel when
they came up out of Egypt.” So the Kenites
departed from among the Amalekites.

7 Saul struck the Amalekites, from
Havilah as you go to Shur, which is before
Egypt.
8 He took Agag the king of the
Amalekites alive, and utterly destroyed all
the people with the edge of the sword.
9 But Saul and the people spared Agag
and the best of the sheep, of the cattle, of
the fat calves, of the lambs, and all that
was good, and were not willing to utterly
destroy them; but everything that was vile
and refuse, that they destroyed utterly.

10 Then Yahweh’s word came to Samuel,
saying,
11 “It grieves me that I have set up Saul
to be king, for he has turned back from
following me, and has not performed my
commandments.” Samuel was angry; and
he cried to Yahweh all night.

12 Samuel rose early to meet Saul in the
morning; and Samuel was told, saying,
“Saul came to Carmel, and behold, he set
up a monument for himself, turned,
passed on, and went down to Gilgal.”

13 Samuel came to Saul; and Saul said to
him, “You are blessed by Yahweh! I have
performed the commandment of
Yahweh.”

14 Samuel said, “Then what does this
bleating of the sheep in my ears and the
lowing of the cattle which I hear mean?”

15 Saul said, “They have brought them
from the Amalekites; for the people
spared the best of the sheep and of the
cattle, to sacrifice to Yahweh your God.
We have utterly destroyed the rest.”

16 Then Samuel said to Saul, “Stay, and I
will tell you what Yahweh said to me last
night.”

He said to him, “Say on.”

17 Samuel said, “Though you were little
in your own sight, weren’t you made the
head of the tribes of Israel? Yahweh
anointed you king over Israel;
18 and Yahweh sent you on a journey,
and said, ‘Go, and utterly destroy the
sinners the Amalekites, and fight against
them until they are consumed.’
19 Why then didn’t you obey Yahweh’s
voice, but took the plunder, and did that
which was evil in Yahweh’s sight?”

20 Saul said to Samuel, “But I have
obeyed Yahweh’s voice, and have gone the
way which Yahweh sent me, and have
brought Agag the king of Amalek, and
have utterly destroyed the Amalekites.
21 But the people took of the plunder,
sheep and cattle, the best of the devoted
things, to sacrifice to Yahweh your God in
Gilgal.”

22 Samuel said, “Has Yahweh as great
delight in burnt offerings and sacrifices,
as in obeying Yahweh’s voice? Behold, to
obey is better than sacrifice, and to listen
than the fat of rams.
23 For rebellion is as the sin of
witchcraft, and stubbornness is as
idolatry and teraphim.† Because you have
rejected Yahweh’s word, he has also
rejected you from being king.”

24 Saul said to Samuel, “I have sinned;
for I have transgressed the
commandment of Yahweh and your
words, because I feared the people and
obeyed their voice.
25 Now therefore, please pardon my sin,
and turn again with me, that I may
worship Yahweh.”
26 Samuel said to Saul, “I will not return
with you; for you have rejected Yahweh’s
word, and Yahweh has rejected you from
being king over Israel.”
27 As Samuel turned around to go away,
Saul grabbed the skirt of his robe, and it
tore.
28 Samuel said to him, “Yahweh has torn
the kingdom of Israel from you today, and
has given it to a neighbor of yours who is
better than you.
29 Also the Strength of Israel will not lie
nor repent; for he is not a man, that he
should repent.”
30 Then he said, “I have sinned; yet
please honor me now before the elders of
my people and before Israel, and come
back with me, that I may worship Yahweh
your God.”
31 So Samuel went back with Saul; and
Saul worshiped Yahweh.
32 Then Samuel said, “Bring Agag the
king of the Amalekites here to me!”

Agag came to him cheerfully. Agag said,
“Surely the bitterness of death is past.”
33 Samuel said, “As your sword has
made women childless, so your mother
will be childless among women!” Then
Samuel cut Agag in pieces before Yahweh
in Gilgal.
34 Then Samuel went to Ramah; and
Saul went up to his house to Gibeah of
Saul.
35 Samuel came no more to see Saul
until the day of his death, but Samuel
mourned for Saul. Yahweh grieved that
he had made Saul king over Israel.

16

1 Yahweh said to Samuel, “How long will
you mourn for Saul, since I have rejected
him from being king over Israel? Fill your
horn with oil, and go. I will send you to
Jesse the Bethlehemite, for I have
provided a king for myself among his
sons.”

† **15:23** teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

2 Samuel said, “How can I go? If Saul
hears it, he will kill me.”
Yahweh said, “Take a heifer with you,
and say, ‘I have come to sacrifice to
Yahweh.’
3 Call Jesse to the sacrifice, and I will
show you what you shall do. You shall
anoint to me him whom I name to you.”
4 Samuel did that which Yahweh spoke,
and came to Bethlehem. The elders of the
city came to meet him trembling, and
said, “Do you come peaceably?”
5 He said, “Peaceably; I have come to
sacrifice to Yahweh. Sanctify yourselves,
and come with me to the sacrifice.” He
sanctified Jesse and his sons, and called
them to the sacrifice.
6 When they had come, he looked at
Eliab, and said, “Surely Yahweh’s
anointed is before him.”
7 But Yahweh said to Samuel, “Don’t
look on his face, or on the height of his
stature, because I have rejected him; for I
don’t see as man sees. For man looks at
the outward appearance, but Yahweh
looks at the heart.”
8 Then Jesse called Abinadab, and made
him pass before Samuel. He said,
“Yahweh has not chosen this one, either.”
9 Then Jesse made Shammah to pass by.
He said, “Yahweh has not chosen this one,
either.”
10 Jesse made seven of his sons to pass
before Samuel. Samuel said to Jesse,
“Yahweh has not chosen these.”
11 Samuel said to Jesse, “Are all your
children here?”
He said, “There remains yet the
youngest. Behold, he is keeping the
sheep.”
Samuel said to Jesse, “Send and get him,
for we will not sit down until he comes
here.”
12 He sent, and brought him in. Now he
was ruddy, with a handsome face and
good appearance. Yahweh said, “Arise!
Anoint him, for this is he.”
13 Then Samuel took the horn of oil and
anointed him in the middle of his
brothers. Then Yahweh’s Spirit came
mightily on David from that day forward.
So Samuel rose up and went to Ramah.
14 Now Yahweh’s Spirit departed from
Saul, and an evil spirit from Yahweh
troubled him.
15 Saul’s servants said to him, “See now,
an evil spirit from God troubles you.
16 Let our lord now command your
servants who are in front of you to seek
out a man who is a skillful player on the
harp. Then when the evil spirit from God
is on you, he will play with his hand, and
you will be well.”
17 Saul said to his servants, “Provide me
now a man who can play well, and bring
him to me.”
18 Then one of the young men answered
and said, “Behold, I have seen a son of
Jesse the Bethlehemite who is skillful in
playing, a mighty man of valor, a man of
war, prudent in speech, and a handsome
person; and Yahweh is with him.”
19 Therefore Saul sent messengers to
Jesse, and said, “Send me David your son,
who is with the sheep.”
20 Jesse took a donkey loaded with
bread, a container of wine, and a young
goat, and sent them by David his son to
Saul.
21 David came to Saul and stood before
him. He loved him greatly; and he became
his armor bearer.
22 Saul sent to Jesse, saying, “Please let
David stand before me, for he has found
favor in my sight.”
23 When the spirit from God was on
Saul, David took the harp and played with
his hand; so Saul was refreshed and was
well, and the evil spirit departed from
him.

17

1 Now the Philistines gathered together
their armies to battle; and they were
gathered together at Socoh, which
belongs to Judah, and encamped between
Socoh and Azekah in Ephesdammim.
2 Saul and the men of Israel were
gathered together, and encamped in the
valley of Elah, and set the battle in array
against the Philistines.
3 The Philistines stood on the mountain
on the one side, and Israel stood on the

mountain on the other side: and there
was a valley between them.
4 A champion out of the camp of the
Philistines named Goliath of Gath, whose
height was six cubits and a span† went
out.
5 He had a helmet of bronze on his head,
and he wore a coat of mail; and the weight
of the coat was five thousand shekels‡ of
bronze.
6 He had bronze shin armor on his legs
and a bronze javelin between his
shoulders.
7 The staff of his spear was like a
weaver's beam; and his spear's head
weighed six hundred shekels of iron.§ His
shield bearer went before him.
8 He stood and cried to the armies of
Israel, and said to them, "Why have you
come out to set your battle in array? Am I
not a Philistine, and you servants to Saul?
Choose a man for yourselves, and let him
come down to me.
9 If he is able to fight with me and kill
me, then will we be your servants; but if I
prevail against him and kill him, then you
will be our servants and serve us."
10 The Philistine said, "I defy the armies
of Israel today! Give me a man, that we
may fight together!"
11 When Saul and all Israel heard those
words of the Philistine, they were
dismayed and greatly afraid.
12 Now David was the son of that
Ephrathite of Bethlehem Judah, whose
name was Jesse; and he had eight sons.
The man was an elderly old man in the
days of Saul.
13 The three oldest sons of Jesse had
gone after Saul to the battle; and the
names of his three sons who went to the
battle were Eliab the firstborn, and next
to him Abinadab, and the third Shammah.
14 David was the youngest; and the
three oldest followed Saul.
15 Now David went back and forth from
Saul to feed his father's sheep at
Bethlehem.
16 The Philistine came near morning
and evening, and presented himself forty
days.
17 Jesse said to David his son, "Now take
for your brothers an ephah† of this
parched grain and these ten loaves, and
carry them quickly to the camp to your
brothers;
18 and bring these ten cheeses to the
captain of their thousand; and see how
your brothers are doing, and bring back
news."
19 Now Saul, and they, and all the men
of Israel were in the valley of Elah,
fighting with the Philistines.
20 David rose up early in the morning
and left the sheep with a keeper, and took
the provisions and went, as Jesse had
commanded him. He came to the place of
the wagons as the army which was going
out to the fight shouted for the battle.
21 Israel and the Philistines put the
battle in array, army against army.
22 David left his baggage in the hand of
the keeper of the baggage and ran to the
army, and came and greeted his brothers.
23 As he talked with them, behold, the
champion, the Philistine of Gath, Goliath
by name, came up out of the ranks of the
Philistines, and said the same words; and
David heard them.
24 All the men of Israel, when they saw
the man, fled from him and were terrified.
25 The men of Israel said, "Have you
seen this man who has come up? He has
surely come up to defy Israel. The king
will give great riches to the man who kills
him, and will give him his daughter, and
will make his father's house tax-free in
Israel."
26 David spoke to the men who stood by
him, saying, "What shall be done to the
man who kills this Philistine and takes
away the reproach from Israel? For who

† **17:4** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. A span is the length from the tip of a man's thumb to the tip of his little finger when his hand is stretched out (about half a cubit, or 9 inches, or 22.8 cm.) Therefore, Goliath was about 9 feet and 9 inches or 2.97 meters tall.

‡ **17:5** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 5000 shekels is about 50 kilograms or 110 pounds. § **17:7** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 600 shekels is about 6 kilograms or about 13 pounds. † **17:17** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies of the living God?"
27 The people answered him in this way, saying, "So shall it be done to the man who kills him."
28 Eliab his oldest brother heard when he spoke to the men; and Eliab's anger burned against David, and he said, "Why have you come down? With whom have you left those few sheep in the wilderness? I know your pride and the evil of your heart; for you have come down that you might see the battle."
29 David said, "What have I now done? Is there not a cause?"
30 He turned away from him toward another, and spoke like that again; and the people answered him again the same way.
31 When the words were heard which David spoke, they rehearsed them before Saul; and he sent for him.
32 David said to Saul, "Let no man's heart fail because of him. Your servant will go and fight with this Philistine."
33 Saul said to David, "You are not able to go against this Philistine to fight with him; for you are but a youth, and he a man of war from his youth."
34 David said to Saul, "Your servant was keeping his father's sheep; and when a lion or a bear came and took a lamb out of the flock,
35 I went out after him, struck him, and rescued it out of his mouth. When he arose against me, I caught him by his beard, struck him, and killed him.
36 Your servant struck both the lion and the bear. This uncircumcised Philistine shall be as one of them, since he has defied the armies of the living God."
37 David said, "Yahweh, who delivered me out of the paw of the lion and out of the paw of the bear, will deliver me out of the hand of this Philistine."
Saul said to David, "Go! Yahweh will be with you."
38 Saul dressed David with his clothing. He put a helmet of bronze on his head, and he clad him with a coat of mail.
39 David strapped his sword on his clothing and he tried to move, for he had not tested it. David said to Saul, "I can't go with these, for I have not tested them." Then David took them off.
40 He took his staff in his hand, and chose for himself five smooth stones out of the brook, and put them in the pouch of his shepherd's bag which he had. His sling was in his hand; and he came near to the Philistine.
41 The Philistine walked and came near to David; and the man who bore the shield went before him.
42 When the Philistine looked around and saw David, he disdained him; for he was but a youth, and ruddy, and had a good looking face.
43 The Philistine said to David, "Am I a dog, that you come to me with sticks?" The Philistine cursed David by his gods.
44 The Philistine said to David, "Come to me, and I will give your flesh to the birds of the sky and to the animals of the field."
45 Then David said to the Philistine, "You come to me with a sword, with a spear, and with a javelin; but I come to you in the name of Yahweh of Armies, the God of the armies of Israel, whom you have defied.
46 Today, Yahweh will deliver you into my hand. I will strike you and take your head from off you. I will give the dead bodies of the army of the Philistines today to the birds of the sky and to the wild animals of the earth, that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel,
47 and that all this assembly may know that Yahweh doesn't save with sword and spear; for the battle is Yahweh's, and he will give you into our hand."
48 When the Philistine arose, and walked and came near to meet David, David hurried and ran toward the army to meet the Philistine.
49 David put his hand in his bag, took a stone and slung it, and struck the Philistine in his forehead. The stone sank into his forehead, and he fell on his face to the earth.
50 So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and struck the Philistine and killed him; but there was no sword in David's hand.
51 Then David ran, stood over the Philistine, took his sword, drew it out of

its sheath, killed him, and cut off his head with it.
When the Philistines saw that their champion was dead, they fled.
52 The men of Israel and of Judah arose and shouted, and pursued the Philistines as far as Gai and to the gates of Ekron. The wounded of the Philistines fell down by the way to Shaaraim, even to Gath and to Ekron.
53 The children of Israel returned from chasing after the Philistines, and they plundered their camp.
54 David took the head of the Philistine and brought it to Jerusalem, but he put his armor in his tent.
55 When Saul saw David go out against the Philistine, he said to Abner, the captain of the army, "Abner, whose son is this youth?"
Abner said, "As your soul lives, O king, I can't tell."
56 The king said, "Inquire whose son the young man is!"
57 As David returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, Abner took him and brought him before Saul with the head of the Philistine in his hand.
58 Saul said to him, "Whose son are you, you young man?"
David answered, "I am the son of your servant Jesse the Bethlehemite."

18

1 When he had finished speaking to Saul, the soul of Jonathan was knit with the soul of David, and Jonathan loved him as his own soul.
2 Saul took him that day, and wouldn't let him go home to his father's house any more.
3 Then Jonathan and David made a covenant, because he loved him as his own soul.
4 Jonathan stripped himself of the robe that was on him and gave it to David with his clothing, even including his sword, his bow, and his sash.
5 David went out wherever Saul sent him, and behaved himself wisely; and Saul set him over the men of war. It was good in the sight of all the people, and also in the sight of Saul's servants.
6 As they came, when David returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, the women came out of all the cities of Israel, singing and dancing, to meet King Saul with tambourines, with joy, and with instruments of music.
7 The women sang to one another as they played, and said,
"Saul has slain his thousands,
and David his ten thousands."
8 Saul was very angry, and this saying displeased him. He said, "They have credited David with ten thousands, and they have only credited me with thousands. What can he have more but the kingdom?"
9 Saul watched David from that day and forward.
10 On the next day, an evil spirit from God came mightily on Saul, and he prophesied in the middle of the house. David played with his hand, as he did day by day. Saul had his spear in his hand;
11 and Saul threw the spear, for he said, "I will pin David to the wall!" David escaped from his presence twice.
12 Saul was afraid of David, because Yahweh was with him, and had departed from Saul.
13 Therefore Saul removed him from his presence, and made him his captain over a thousand; and he went out and came in before the people.
14 David behaved himself wisely in all his ways; and Yahweh was with him.
15 When Saul saw that he behaved himself very wisely, he stood in awe of him.
16 But all Israel and Judah loved David; for he went out and came in before them.
17 Saul said to David, "Behold, my elder daughter Merab. I will give her to you as wife. Only be valiant for me, and fight Yahweh's battles." For Saul said, "Don't let my hand be on him, but let the hand of the Philistines be on him."
18 David said to Saul, "Who am I, and what is my life, or my father's family in Israel, that I should be son-in-law to the king?"
19 But at the time when Merab, Saul's daughter, should have been given to

David, she was given to Adriel the Meholathite as wife.

20 Michal, Saul's daughter, loved David;
and they told Saul, and the thing pleased him.
21 Saul said, I will give her to him, that she may be a snare to him and that the hand of the Philistines may be against him. Therefore Saul said to David a second time, "You shall today be my son-in-law."

22 Saul commanded his servants, "Talk with David secretly, and say, 'Behold, the king has delight in you, and all his servants love you. Now therefore be the king's son-in-law.' "

23 Saul's servants spoke those words in the ears of David. David said, "Does it seem to you a light thing to be the king's son-in-law, since I am a poor man and little known?"

24 The servants of Saul told him, saying, "David spoke like this."

25 Saul said, "Tell David, 'The king desires no dowry except one hundred foreskins of the Philistines, to be avenged of the king's enemies.' " Now Saul thought he would make David fall by the hand of the Philistines.
26 When his servants told David these words, it pleased David well to be the king's son-in-law. Before the deadline,
27 David arose and went, he and his men, and killed two hundred men of the Philistines. Then David brought their foreskins, and they gave them in full number to the king, that he might be the king's son-in-law. Then Saul gave him Michal his daughter as wife.
28 Saul saw and knew that Yahweh was with David; and Michal, Saul's daughter, loved him.
29 Saul was even more afraid of David;
and Saul was David's enemy continually.

30 Then the princes of the Philistines went out; and as often as they went out, David behaved himself more wisely than all the servants of Saul, so that his name was highly esteemed.

19

1 Saul spoke to Jonathan his son and to all his servants, that they should kill David. But Jonathan, Saul's son, greatly delighted in David.
2 Jonathan told David, saying, "Saul my father seeks to kill you. Now therefore, please take care of yourself in the morning, live in a secret place, and hide yourself.
3 I will go out and stand beside my father in the field where you are, and I will talk with my father about you; and if I see anything, I will tell you."
4 Jonathan spoke good of David to Saul his father, and said to him, "Don't let the king sin against his servant, against David; because he has not sinned against you, and because his works have been very good toward you;
5 for he put his life in his hand and struck the Philistine, and Yahweh worked a great victory for all Israel. You saw it and rejoiced. Why then will you sin against innocent blood, to kill David without a cause?"
6 Saul listened to the voice of Jonathan;
and Saul swore, "As Yahweh lives, he shall not be put to death."
7 Jonathan called David, and Jonathan showed him all those things. Then Jonathan brought David to Saul, and he was in his presence as before.
8 There was war again. David went out and fought with the Philistines, and killed them with a great slaughter; and they fled before him.
9 An evil spirit from Yahweh was on Saul as he sat in his house with his spear in his hand; and David was playing music with his hand.
10 Saul sought to pin David to the wall with the spear, but he slipped away out of Saul's presence; and he stuck the spear into the wall. David fled and escaped that night.
11 Saul sent messengers to David's house to watch him and to kill him in the morning. Michal, David's wife, told him, saying, "If you don't save your life tonight, tomorrow you will be killed."

12 So Michal let David down through the window. He went away, fled, and escaped.
13 Michal took the teraphim† and laid it in the bed, and put a pillow of goats' hair at its head and covered it with clothes.
14 When Saul sent messengers to take David, she said, "He is sick."

15 Saul sent the messengers to see David, saying, "Bring him up to me in the bed, that I may kill him."
16 When the messengers came in, behold, the teraphim was in the bed, with the pillow of goats' hair at its head.

17 Saul said to Michal, "Why have you deceived me like this and let my enemy go, so that he has escaped?"

Michal answered Saul, "He said to me, 'Let me go! Why should I kill you?' "

18 Now David fled and escaped, and came to Samuel at Ramah, and told him all that Saul had done to him. He and Samuel went and lived in Naioth.
19 Saul was told, saying, "Behold, David is at Naioth in Ramah."
20 Saul sent messengers to seize David; and when they saw the company of the prophets prophesying, and Samuel standing as head over them, God's Spirit came on Saul's messengers, and they also prophesied.
21 When Saul was told, he sent other messengers, and they also prophesied. Saul sent messengers again the third time, and they also prophesied.
22 Then he also went to Ramah, and came to the great well that is in Secu: and he asked, "Where are Samuel and David?"

One said, "Behold, they are at Naioth in Ramah."

23 He went there to Naioth in Ramah. Then God's Spirit came on him also, and he went on, and prophesied, until he came to Naioth in Ramah.
24 He also stripped off his clothes. He also prophesied before Samuel and lay down naked all that day and all that night. Therefore they say, "Is Saul also among the prophets?"

20

1 David fled from Naioth in Ramah, and came and said to Jonathan, "What have I done? What is my iniquity? What is my sin before your father, that he seeks my life?"

2 He said to him, "Far from it; you will not die. Behold, my father does nothing either great or small, but that he discloses it to me. Why would my father hide this thing from me? It is not so."

3 David swore moreover, and said, "Your father knows well that I have found favor in your eyes; and he says, 'Don't let Jonathan know this, lest he be grieved;' but truly as Yahweh lives, and as your soul lives, there is but a step between me and death."

4 Then Jonathan said to David, "Whatever your soul desires, I will even do it for you."

5 David said to Jonathan, "Behold, tomorrow is the new moon, and I should not fail to dine with the king; but let me go, that I may hide myself in the field to the third day at evening.
6 If your father misses me at all, then say, 'David earnestly asked leave of me that he might run to Bethlehem, his city; for it is the yearly sacrifice there for all the family.'
7 If he says, 'It is well,' your servant shall have peace; but if he is angry, then know that evil is determined by him.
8 Therefore deal kindly with your servant, for you have brought your servant into a covenant of Yahweh with you; but if there is iniquity in me, kill me yourself, for why should you bring me to your father?"

9 Jonathan said, "Far be it from you; for if I should at all know that evil were determined by my father to come on you, then wouldn't I tell you that?"

10 Then David said to Jonathan, "Who will tell me if your father answers you roughly?"

† **19:13** teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

11 Jonathan said to David, “Come! Let’s
go out into the field.” They both went out
into the field.
12 Jonathan said to David, “By Yahweh,
the God of Israel, when I have sounded
out my father about this time tomorrow,
or the third day, behold, if there is good
toward David, won’t I then send to you
and disclose it to you?
13 Yahweh do so to Jonathan and more
also, should it please my father to do you
evil, if I don’t disclose it to you and send
you away, that you may go in peace. May
Yahweh be with you as he has been with
my father.
14 You shall not only show me the loving
kindness of Yahweh while I still live, that I
not die;
15 but you shall also not cut off your
kindness from my house forever, no, not
when Yahweh has cut off every one of the
enemies of David from the surface of the
earth.”
16 So Jonathan made a covenant with
David’s house, saying, “Yahweh will
require it at the hand of David’s enemies.”
17 Jonathan caused David to swear
again, for the love that he had for him; for
he loved him as he loved his own soul.
18 Then Jonathan said to him,
“Tomorrow is the new moon, and you will
be missed, because your seat will be
empty.
19 When you have stayed three days, go
down quickly and come to the place
where you hid yourself when this started,
and remain by the stone Ezel.
20 I will shoot three arrows on its side,
as though I shot at a mark.
21 Behold, I will send the boy, saying,
‘Go, find the arrows!’ If I tell the boy,
‘Behold, the arrows are on this side of you.
Take them;’ then come, for there is peace
to you and no danger, as Yahweh lives.
22 But if I say this to the boy, ‘Behold, the
arrows are beyond you,’ then go your
way, for Yahweh has sent you away.
23 Concerning the matter which you and
I have spoken of, behold, Yahweh is
between you and me forever.”
24 So David hid himself in the field.
When the new moon had come, the king
sat himself down to eat food.
25 The king sat on his seat, as at other
times, even on the seat by the wall; and
Jonathan stood up, and Abner sat by
Saul’s side, but David’s place was empty.
26 Nevertheless Saul didn’t say anything
that day, for he thought, “Something has
happened to him. He is not clean. Surely
he is not clean.”
27 On the next day after the new moon,
the second day, David’s place was empty.
Saul said to Jonathan his son, “Why didn’t
the son of Jesse come to eat, either
yesterday, or today?”
28 Jonathan answered Saul, “David
earnestly asked permission of me to go to
Bethlehem.
29 He said, ‘Please let me go, for our
family has a sacrifice in the city. My
brother has commanded me to be there.
Now, if I have found favor in your eyes,
please let me go away and see my
brothers.’ Therefore he has not come to
the king’s table.”
30 Then Saul’s anger burned against
Jonathan, and he said to him, “You son of a
perverse rebellious woman, don’t I know
that you have chosen the son of Jesse to
your own shame, and to the shame of
your mother’s nakedness?
31 For as long as the son of Jesse lives on
the earth, you will not be established, nor
will your kingdom. Therefore now send
and bring him to me, for he shall surely
die!”
32 Jonathan answered Saul his father,
and said to him, “Why should he be put to
death? What has he done?”
33 Saul cast his spear at him to strike
him. By this Jonathan knew that his father
was determined to put David to death.
34 So Jonathan arose from the table in
fierce anger, and ate no food the second
day of the month; for he was grieved for
David, because his father had treated him
shamefully.
35 In the morning, Jonathan went out
into the field at the time appointed with
David, and a little boy with him.

36 He said to his boy, “Run, find now the
arrows which I shoot.” As the boy ran, he
shot an arrow beyond him.
37 When the boy had come to the place
of the arrow which Jonathan had shot,
Jonathan cried after the boy, and said,
“Isn’t the arrow beyond you?”
38 Jonathan cried after the boy, “Go fast!
Hurry! Don’t delay!” Jonathan’s boy
gathered up the arrows, and came to his
master.
39 But the boy didn’t know anything.
Only Jonathan and David knew the
matter.
40 Jonathan gave his weapons to his boy,
and said to him, “Go, carry them to the
city.”
41 As soon as the boy was gone, David
arose out of the south, and fell on his face
to the ground, and bowed himself three
times. They kissed one another and wept
with one another, and David wept the
most.
42 Jonathan said to David, “Go in peace,
because we have both sworn in Yahweh’s
name, saying, ‘Yahweh is between me and
you, and between my offspring and your
offspring, forever.’ ” He arose and
departed; and Jonathan went into the city.

21

1 Then David came to Nob to Ahimelech
the priest. Ahimelech came to meet David
trembling, and said to him, “Why are you
alone, and no man with you?”
2 David said to Ahimelech the priest,
“The king has commanded me to do
something, and has said to me, ‘Let no one
know anything about the business about
which I send you, and what I have
commanded you. I have sent the young
men to a certain place.’
3 Now therefore what is under your
hand? Please give me five loaves of bread
in my hand, or whatever is available.”
4 The priest answered David, and said,
“I have no common bread, but there is
holy bread; if only the young men have
kept themselves from women.”
5 David answered the priest, and said to
him, “Truly, women have been kept from
us as usual these three days. When I came
out, the vessels of the young men were
holy, though it was only a common
journey. How much more then today shall
their vessels be holy?”
6 So the priest gave him holy bread; for
there was no bread there but the show
bread that was taken from before
Yahweh, to be replaced with hot bread in
the day when it was taken away.
7 Now a certain man of the servants of
Saul was there that day, detained before
Yahweh; and his name was Doeg the
Edomite, the best of the herdsmen who
belonged to Saul.
8 David said to Ahimelech, “Isn’t there
here under your hand spear or sword?
For I haven’t brought my sword or my
weapons with me, because the king’s
business required haste.”
9 The priest said, “Behold, the sword of
Goliath the Philistine, whom you killed in
the valley of Elah, is here wrapped in a
cloth behind the ephod. If you would like
to take that, take it, for there is no other
except that here.”

David said, “There is none like that.
Give it to me.”
10 David arose and fled that day for fear
of Saul, and went to Achish the king of
Gath.
11 The servants of Achish said to him,
“Isn’t this David the king of the land?
Didn’t they sing to one another about him
in dances, saying,

‘Saul has slain his thousands,
and David his ten thousands’?”

12 David laid up these words in his
heart, and was very afraid of Achish the
king of Gath.
13 He changed his behavior before them
and pretended to be insane in their hands,
and scribbled on the doors of the gate,
and let his spittle fall down on his beard.
14 Then Achish said to his servants,
“Look, you see the man is insane. Why
then have you brought him to me?
15 Do I lack madmen, that you have
brought this fellow to play the madman in
my presence? Should this fellow come
into my house?”

22

1 David therefore departed from there
and escaped to Adullam's cave. When his
brothers and all his father's house heard
it, they went down there to him.
2 Everyone who was in distress,
everyone who was in debt, and everyone
who was discontented gathered
themselves to him; and he became
captain over them. There were with him
about four hundred men.
3 David went from there to Mizpeh of
Moab; and he said to the king of Moab,
"Please let my father and my mother
come out to you, until I know what God
will do for me."
4 He brought them before the king of
Moab; and they lived with him all the time
that David was in the stronghold.
5 The prophet Gad said to David, "Don't
stay in the stronghold. Depart, and go into
the land of Judah."

Then David departed, and came into the
forest of Hereth.
6 Saul heard that David was discovered,
with the men who were with him. Now
Saul was sitting in Gibeah, under the
tamarisk tree in Ramah, with his spear in
his hand, and all his servants were
standing around him.
7 Saul said to his servants who stood
around him, "Hear now, you Benjamites!
Will the son of Jesse give everyone of you
fields and vineyards? Will he make you
all captains of thousands and captains of
hundreds?
8 Is that why all of you have conspired
against me, and there is no one who
discloses to me when my son makes a
treaty with the son of Jesse, and there is
none of you who is sorry for me, or
discloses to me that my son has stirred up
my servant against me, to lie in wait, as it
is today?"

9 Then Doeg the Edomite, who stood by
the servants of Saul, answered and said, "I
saw the son of Jesse coming to Nob, to
Ahimelech the son of Ahitub.
10 He inquired of Yahweh for him, gave
him food, and gave him the sword of
Goliath the Philistine."
11 Then the king sent to call Ahimelech
the priest, the son of Ahitub, and all his
father's house, the priests who were in
Nob; and they all came to the king.
12 Saul said, "Hear now, you son of
Ahitub."
He answered, "Here I am, my lord."
13 Saul said to him, "Why have you
conspired against me, you and the son of
Jesse, in that you have given him bread,
and a sword, and have inquired of God for
him, that he should rise against me, to lie
in wait, as it is today?"
14 Then Ahimelech answered the king,
and said, "Who among all your servants is
so faithful as David, who is the king's
son-in-law, captain of your body guard,
and honored in your house?
15 Have I today begun to inquire of God
for him? Be it far from me! Don't let the
king impute anything to his servant, nor
to all the house of my father; for your
servant knew nothing of all this, less or
more."
16 The king said, "You shall surely die,
Ahimelech, you and all your father's
house."
17 The king said to the guard who stood
about him, "Turn and kill the priests of
Yahweh, because their hand also is with
David, and because they knew that he fled
and didn't disclose it to me." But the
servants of the king wouldn't put out their
hand to fall on the priests of Yahweh.
18 The king said to Doeg, "Turn and
attack the priests!"

Doeg the Edomite turned, and he
attacked the priests, and he killed on that
day eighty-five people who wore a linen
ephod.
19 He struck Nob, the city of the priests,
with the edge of the sword—both men and
women, children and nursing babies, and
cattle, donkeys, and sheep, with the edge
of the sword.
20 One of the sons of Ahimelech the son
of Ahitub, named Abiathar, escaped and
fled after David.
21 Abiathar told David that Saul had
slain Yahweh's priests.
22 David said to Abiathar, "I knew on
that day, when Doeg the Edomite was

there, that he would surely tell Saul. I am responsible for the death of all the persons of your father's house.
23 Stay with me. Don't be afraid, for he who seeks my life seeks your life. You will be safe with me."

23

1 David was told, "Behold, the Philistines are fighting against Keilah, and are robbing the threshing floors."
2 Therefore David inquired of Yahweh, saying, "Shall I go and strike these Philistines?"
Yahweh said to David, "Go strike the Philistines, and save Keilah."
3 David's men said to him, "Behold, we are afraid here in Judah. How much more then if we go to Keilah against the armies of the Philistines?"
4 Then David inquired of Yahweh yet again. Yahweh answered him, and said, "Arise, go down to Keilah; for I will deliver the Philistines into your hand."
5 David and his men went to Keilah and fought with the Philistines, and brought away their livestock, and killed them with a great slaughter. So David saved the inhabitants of Keilah.
6 When Abiathar the son of Ahimelech fled to David to Keilah, he came down with an ephod in his hand.
7 Saul was told that David had come to Keilah. Saul said, "God has delivered him into my hand, for he is shut in by entering into a town that has gates and bars."
8 Saul summoned all the people to war, to go down to Keilah to besiege David and his men.
9 David knew that Saul was devising mischief against him. He said to Abiathar the priest, "Bring the ephod here."
10 Then David said, "O Yahweh, the God of Israel, your servant has surely heard that Saul seeks to come to Keilah to destroy the city for my sake.
11 Will the men of Keilah deliver me up into his hand? Will Saul come down, as your servant has heard? Yahweh, the God of Israel, I beg you, tell your servant."
Yahweh said, "He will come down."
12 Then David said, "Will the men of Keilah deliver me and my men into the hand of Saul?"
Yahweh said, "They will deliver you up."
13 Then David and his men, who were about six hundred, arose and departed out of Keilah and went wherever they could go. Saul was told that David had escaped from Keilah; and he gave up going there.
14 David stayed in the wilderness in the strongholds, and remained in the hill country in the wilderness of Ziph. Saul sought him every day, but God didn't deliver him into his hand.
15 David saw that Saul had come out to seek his life. David was in the wilderness of Ziph in the woods.
16 Jonathan, Saul's son, arose and went to David into the woods, and strengthened his hand in God.
17 He said to him, "Don't be afraid, for the hand of Saul my father won't find you; and you will be king over Israel, and I will be next to you; and Saul my father knows that also."
18 They both made a covenant before Yahweh. Then David stayed in the woods and Jonathan went to his house.
19 Then the Ziphites came up to Saul to Gibeah, saying, "Doesn't David hide himself with us in the strongholds in the woods, in the hill of Hachilah, which is on the south of the desert?
20 Now therefore, O king, come down. According to all the desire of your soul to come down; and our part will be to deliver him up into the king's hand."
21 Saul said, "You are blessed by Yahweh, for you have had compassion on me.
22 Please go make yet more sure, and know and see his place where his haunt is, and who has seen him there; for I have been told that he is very cunning.
23 See therefore, and take knowledge of all the lurking places where he hides himself; and come again to me with certainty, and I will go with you. It shall happen, if he is in the land, that I will search him out among all the thousands of Judah."

24 They arose, and went to Ziph before
Saul; but David and his men were in the
wilderness of Maon, in the Arabah on the
south of the desert.
25 Saul and his men went to seek him.
When David was told, he went down to
the rock, and stayed in the wilderness of
Maon. When Saul heard that, he pursued
David in the wilderness of Maon.
26 Saul went on this side of the
mountain, and David and his men on that
side of the mountain; and David hurried
to get away for fear of Saul, for Saul and
his men surrounded David and his men to
take them.
27 But a messenger came to Saul, saying,
"Hurry and come, for the Philistines have
made a raid on the land!"
28 So Saul returned from pursuing
David, and went against the Philistines.
Therefore they called that place Sela
Hammahlekoth.†
29 David went up from there and lived
in the strongholds of En Gedi.

24

1 When Saul had returned from
following the Philistines, he was told,
"Behold, David is in the wilderness of En
Gedi."
2 Then Saul took three thousand chosen
men out of all Israel, and went to seek
David and his men on the rocks of the
wild goats.
3 He came to the sheep pens by the way,
where there was a cave; and Saul went in
to relieve himself. Now David and his
men were staying in the innermost parts
of the cave.
4 David's men said to him, "Behold, the
day of which Yahweh said to you, 'Behold,
I will deliver your enemy into your hand,
and you shall do to him as it shall seem
good to you.' " Then David arose and cut
off the skirt of Saul's robe secretly.
5 Afterward, David's heart struck him
because he had cut off Saul's skirt.
6 He said to his men, "Yahweh forbid
that I should do this thing to my lord,
Yahweh's anointed, to stretch out my
hand against him, since he is Yahweh's
anointed."
7 So David checked his men with these
words, and didn't allow them to rise
against Saul. Saul rose up out of the cave,
and went on his way.
8 David also arose afterward, and went
out of the cave and cried after Saul,
saying, "My lord the king!"
When Saul looked behind him, David
bowed with his face to the earth, and
showed respect.
9 David said to Saul, "Why do you listen
to men's words, saying, 'Behold, David
seeks to harm you'?
10 Behold, today your eyes have seen
how Yahweh had delivered you today into
my hand in the cave. Some urged me to
kill you, but I spared you. I said, 'I will not
stretch out my hand against my lord, for
he is Yahweh's anointed.'
11 Moreover, my father, behold, yes, see
the skirt of your robe in my hand; for in
that I cut off the skirt of your robe and
didn't kill you, know and see that there is
neither evil nor disobedience in my hand.
I have not sinned against you, though you
hunt for my life to take it.
12 May Yahweh judge between me and
you, and may Yahweh avenge me of you;
but my hand will not be on you.
13 As the proverb of the ancients says,
'Out of the wicked comes wickedness;' but
my hand will not be on you.
14 Against whom has the king of Israel
come out? Whom do you pursue? A dead
dog? A flea?
15 May Yahweh therefore be judge, and
give sentence between me and you, and
see, and plead my cause, and deliver me
out of your hand."
16 It came to pass, when David had
finished speaking these words to Saul,
that Saul said, "Is that your voice, my son
David?" Saul lifted up his voice and wept.
17 He said to David, "You are more
righteous than I; for you have done good
to me, whereas I have done evil to you.
18 You have declared today how you
have dealt well with me, because when
Yahweh had delivered me up into your
hand, you didn't kill me.

† **23:28** "Sela Hammahlekoth" means "rock of parting".

19 For if a man finds his enemy, will he
let him go away unharmed? Therefore
may Yahweh reward you good for that
which you have done to me today.
20 Now, behold, I know that you will
surely be king, and that the kingdom of
Israel will be established in your hand.
21 Swear now therefore to me by
Yahweh that you will not cut off my
offspring after me, and that you will not
destroy my name out of my father's
house."
22 David swore to Saul. Saul went home,
but David and his men went up to the
stronghold.

25

1 Samuel died; and all Israel gathered
themselves together and mourned for
him, and buried him at his house at
Ramah.
Then David arose and went down to the
wilderness of Paran.
2 There was a man in Maon whose
possessions were in Carmel; and the man
was very great. He had three thousand
sheep and a thousand goats; and he was
shearing his sheep in Carmel.
3 Now the name of the man was Nabal;
and the name of his wife Abigail. This
woman was intelligent and had a
beautiful face; but the man was surly and
evil in his doings. He was of the house of
Caleb.
4 David heard in the wilderness that
Nabal was shearing his sheep.
5 David sent ten young men; and David
said to the young men, "Go up to Carmel,
and go to Nabal, and greet him in my
name.
6 Tell him, 'Long life to you! Peace be to
you! Peace be to your house! Peace be to
all that you have!
7 Now I have heard that you have
shearers. Your shepherds have now been
with us, and we didn't harm them.
Nothing was missing from them all the
time they were in Carmel.
8 Ask your young men, and they will tell
you. Therefore let the young men find
favor in your eyes, for we come on a good
day. Please give whatever comes to your
hand to your servants and to your son
David.' "
9 When David's young men came, they
spoke to Nabal all those words in the
name of David, and waited.
10 Nabal answered David's servants and
said, "Who is David? Who is the son of
Jesse? There are many servants who
break away from their masters these days.
11 Shall I then take my bread, my water,
and my meat that I have killed for my
shearers, and give it to men who I don't
know where they come from?"
12 So David's young men turned on their
way and went back, and came and told
him all these words.
13 David said to his men, "Every man
put on his sword!"
Every man put on his sword. David also
put on his sword. About four hundred
men followed David, and two hundred
stayed by the baggage.
14 But one of the young men told Abigail,
Nabal's wife, saying, "Behold, David sent
messengers out of the wilderness to greet
our master; and he insulted them.
15 But the men were very good to us,
and we were not harmed, and we didn't
miss anything as long as we went with
them, when we were in the fields.
16 They were a wall to us both by night
and by day, all the while we were with
them keeping the sheep.
17 Now therefore know and consider
what you will do; for evil is determined
against our master and against all his
house, for he is such a worthless fellow
that one can't speak to him."
18 Then Abigail hurried and took two
hundred loaves of bread, two containers
of wine, five sheep ready dressed, five
seahs† of parched grain, one hundred
clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes
of figs, and laid them on donkeys.
19 She said to her young men, "Go on
before me. Behold, I am coming after
you." But she didn't tell her husband,
Nabal.

† **25:18** 1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks

20 As she rode on her donkey, and came
down hidden by the mountain, behold,
David and his men came down toward
her, and she met them.
21 Now David had said, “Surely in vain I
have kept all that this fellow has in the
wilderness, so that nothing was missed of
all that pertained to him. He has returned
me evil for good.
22 God do so to the enemies of David,
and more also, if I leave of all that belongs
to him by the morning light so much as
one who urinates on a wall.”‡
23 When Abigail saw David, she hurried
and got off her donkey, and fell before
David on her face and bowed herself to
the ground.
24 She fell at his feet and said, “On me,
my lord, on me be the blame! Please let
your servant speak in your ears. Hear the
words of your servant.
25 Please don’t let my lord pay attention
to this worthless fellow, Nabal, for as his
name is, so is he. Nabal§ is his name, and
folly is with him; but I, your servant,
didn’t see my lord’s young men whom you
sent.
26 Now therefore, my lord, as Yahweh
lives and as your soul lives, since Yahweh
has withheld you from blood guiltiness
and from avenging yourself with your
own hand, now therefore let your
enemies and those who seek evil to my
lord be as Nabal.
27 Now this present which your servant
has brought to my lord, let it be given to
the young men who follow my lord.
28 Please forgive the trespass of your
servant. For Yahweh will certainly make
my lord a sure house, because my lord
fights Yahweh’s battles. Evil will not be
found in you all your days.
29 Though men may rise up to pursue
you and to seek your soul, yet the soul of
my lord will be bound in the bundle of life
with Yahweh your God. He will sling out
the souls of your enemies as from a sling’s
pocket.
30 It will come to pass, when Yahweh
has done to my lord according to all the
good that he has spoken concerning you,
and has appointed you prince over Israel,
31 that this shall be no grief to you, nor
offense of heart to my lord, either that you
have shed blood without cause, or that my
lord has avenged himself. When Yahweh
has dealt well with my lord, then
remember your servant.”
32 David said to Abigail, “Blessed is
Yahweh, the God of Israel, who sent you
today to meet me!
33 Blessed is your discretion, and
blessed are you, who have kept me today
from blood guiltiness, and from avenging
myself with my own hand.
34 For indeed, as Yahweh the God of
Israel lives, who has withheld me from
harming you, unless you had hurried and
come to meet me, surely there wouldn’t
have been left to Nabal by the morning
light so much as one who urinates on a
wall.”†
35 So David received from her hand that
which she had brought him. Then he said
to her, “Go up in peace to your house.
Behold, I have listened to your voice and
have granted your request.”
36 Abigail came to Nabal; and behold, he
held a feast in his house like the feast of a
king. Nabal’s heart was merry within him,
for he was very drunk. Therefore she told
him nothing until the morning light.
37 In the morning, when the wine had
gone out of Nabal, his wife told him these
things; and his heart died within him, and
he became as a stone.
38 About ten days later, Yahweh struck
Nabal, so that he died.
39 When David heard that Nabal was
dead, he said, “Blessed is Yahweh, who has
pleaded the cause of my reproach from
the hand of Nabal, and has kept back his
servant from evil. Yahweh has returned
the evildoing of Nabal on his own head.”
David sent and spoke concerning
Abigail, to take her to himself as wife.
40 When David’s servants had come to
Abigail to Carmel, they spoke to her,
saying, “David has sent us to you, to take
you to him as wife.”

‡ **25:22** or, male. § **25:25** “Nabal” means “foolish”. † **25:34** or, one male.

41 She arose and bowed herself with her face to the earth, and said, “Behold, your servant is a servant to wash the feet of the servants of my lord.”
42 Abigail hurriedly arose and rode on a donkey with her five maids who followed her; and she went after the messengers of David, and became his wife.
43 David also took Ahinoam of Jezreel; and they both became his wives.
44 Now Saul had given Michal his daughter, David’s wife, to Palti the son of Laish, who was of Gallim.

26

1 The Ziphites came to Saul to Gibeah, saying, “Doesn’t David hide himself in the hill of Hachilah, which is before the desert?”
2 Then Saul arose and went down to the wilderness of Ziph, having three thousand chosen men of Israel with him, to seek David in the wilderness of Ziph.
3 Saul encamped in the hill of Hachilah, which is before the desert, by the way. But David stayed in the wilderness, and he saw that Saul came after him into the wilderness.
4 David therefore sent out spies, and understood that Saul had certainly come.
5 Then David arose and came to the place where Saul had encamped; and David saw the place where Saul lay, with Abner the son of Ner, the captain of his army. Saul lay within the place of the wagons, and the people were encamped around him.
6 Then David answered and said to Ahimelech the Hittite, and to Abishai the son of Zeruiah, brother of Joab, saying, “Who will go down with me to Saul to the camp?”
Abishai said, “I will go down with you.”
7 So David and Abishai came to the people by night; and, behold, Saul lay sleeping within the place of the wagons, with his spear stuck in the ground at his head; and Abner and the people lay around him.
8 Then Abishai said to David, “God has delivered up your enemy into your hand today. Now therefore please let me strike him with the spear to the earth at one stroke, and I will not strike him the second time.”
9 David said to Abishai, “Don’t destroy him, for who can stretch out his hand against Yahweh’s anointed, and be guiltless?”
10 David said, “As Yahweh lives, Yahweh will strike him; or his day shall come to die, or he shall go down into battle and perish.
11 Yahweh forbid that I should stretch out my hand against Yahweh’s anointed; but now please take the spear that is at his head and the jar of water, and let’s go.”
12 So David took the spear and the jar of water from Saul’s head, and they went away. No man saw it, or knew it, nor did any awake; for they were all asleep, because a deep sleep from Yahweh had fallen on them.
13 Then David went over to the other side, and stood on the top of the mountain far away, a great space being between them;
14 and David cried to the people, and to Abner the son of Ner, saying, “Don’t you answer, Abner?”
Then Abner answered, “Who are you who calls to the king?”
15 David said to Abner, “Aren’t you a man? Who is like you in Israel? Why then have you not kept watch over your lord the king? For one of the people came in to destroy your lord the king.
16 This thing isn’t good that you have done. As Yahweh lives, you are worthy to die, because you have not kept watch over your lord, Yahweh’s anointed. Now see where the king’s spear is, and the jar of water that was at his head.”
17 Saul recognized David’s voice, and said, “Is this your voice, my son David?”
David said, “It is my voice, my lord, O king.”
18 He said, “Why does my lord pursue his servant? For what have I done? What evil is in my hand?
19 Now therefore, please let my lord the king hear the words of his servant. If it is so that Yahweh has stirred you up against me, let him accept an offering. But if it is the children of men, they are cursed

before Yahweh; for they have driven me out today that I shouldn't cling to Yahweh's inheritance, saying, 'Go, serve other gods!'
20 Now therefore, don't let my blood fall to the earth away from the presence of Yahweh; for the king of Israel has come out to seek a flea, as when one hunts a partridge in the mountains."
21 Then Saul said, "I have sinned. Return, my son David; for I will no more do you harm, because my life was precious in your eyes today. Behold, I have played the fool, and have erred exceedingly."
22 David answered, "Behold the spear, O king! Let one of the young men come over and get it.
23 Yahweh will give to every man his righteousness and his faithfulness; because Yahweh delivered you into my hand today, and I wouldn't stretch out my hand against Yahweh's anointed.
24 Behold, as your life was respected today in my eyes, so let my life be respected in Yahweh's eyes, and let him deliver me out of all oppression."
25 Then Saul said to David, "You are blessed, my son David. You will both do mightily, and will surely prevail."
So David went his way, and Saul returned to his place.

27

1 David said in his heart, "I will now perish one day by the hand of Saul. There is nothing better for me than that I should escape into the land of the Philistines; and Saul will despair of me, to seek me any more in all the borders of Israel. So I will escape out of his hand."
2 David arose and passed over, he and the six hundred men who were with him, to Achish the son of Maoch, king of Gath.
3 David lived with Achish at Gath, he and his men, every man with his household, even David with his two wives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess and Abigail the Carmelitess, Nabal's wife.
4 Saul was told that David had fled to Gath, so he stopped looking for him.
5 David said to Achish, "If now I have found favor in your eyes, let them give me a place in one of the cities in the country, that I may dwell there. For why should your servant dwell in the royal city with you?"
6 Then Achish gave him Ziklag that day: therefore Ziklag belongs to the kings of Judah to this day.
7 The number of the days that David lived in the country of the Philistines was a full year and four months.
8 David and his men went up and raided the Geshurites, the Girzites, and the Amalekites; for those were the inhabitants of the land who were of old, on the way to Shur, even to the land of Egypt.
9 David struck the land, and saved no man or woman alive, and took away the sheep, the cattle, the donkeys, the camels, and the clothing. Then he returned, and came to Achish.
10 Achish said, "Against whom have you made a raid today?"
David said, "Against the South of Judah, against the South of the Jerahmeelites, and against the South of the Kenites."
11 David saved neither man nor woman alive to bring them to Gath, saying, "Lest they should tell about us, saying, 'David did this, and this has been his way all the time he has lived in the country of the Philistines.' "
12 Achish believed David, saying, "He has made his people Israel utterly to abhor him. Therefore he will be my servant forever."

28

1 In those days, the Philistines gathered their armies together for warfare, to fight with Israel. Achish said to David, "Know assuredly that you will go out with me in the army, you and your men."
2 David said to Achish, "Therefore you will know what your servant can do."
Achish said to David, "Therefore I will make you my bodyguard forever."
3 Now Samuel was dead, and all Israel had mourned for him and buried him in Ramah, even in his own city. Saul had

sent away those who had familiar spirits and the wizards out of the land.
4 The Philistines gathered themselves together, and came and encamped in Shunem; and Saul gathered all Israel together, and they encamped in Gilboa.
5 When Saul saw the army of the Philistines, he was afraid, and his heart trembled greatly.
6 When Saul inquired of Yahweh, Yahweh didn't answer him by dreams, by Urim, or by prophets.
7 Then Saul said to his servants, "Seek for me a woman who has a familiar spirit, that I may go to her and inquire of her."
His servants said to him, "Behold, there is a woman who has a familiar spirit at Endor."
8 Saul disguised himself and put on other clothing, and went, he and two men with him, and they came to the woman by night. Then he said, "Please consult for me by the familiar spirit, and bring me up whomever I shall name to you."
9 The woman said to him, "Behold, you know what Saul has done, how he has cut off those who have familiar spirits and the wizards out of the land. Why then do you lay a snare for my life, to cause me to die?"
10 Saul swore to her by Yahweh, saying, "As Yahweh lives, no punishment will happen to you for this thing."
11 Then the woman said, "Whom shall I bring up to you?"
He said, "Bring Samuel up for me."
12 When the woman saw Samuel, she cried with a loud voice; and the woman spoke to Saul, saying, "Why have you deceived me? For you are Saul!"
13 The king said to her, "Don't be afraid! What do you see?"
The woman said to Saul, "I see a god coming up out of the earth."
14 He said to her, "What does he look like?"
She said, "An old man comes up. He is covered with a robe." Saul perceived that it was Samuel, and he bowed with his face to the ground, and showed respect.
15 Samuel said to Saul, "Why have you disturbed me, to bring me up?"
Saul answered, "I am very distressed; for the Philistines make war against me, and God has departed from me, and answers me no more, by prophets, or by dreams. Therefore I have called you, that you may make known to me what I shall do."
16 Samuel said, "Why then do you ask me, since Yahweh has departed from you and has become your adversary?
17 Yahweh has done to you as he spoke by me. Yahweh has torn the kingdom out of your hand and given it to your neighbor, even to David.
18 Because you didn't obey Yahweh's voice, and didn't execute his fierce wrath on Amalek, therefore Yahweh has done this thing to you today.
19 Moreover Yahweh will deliver Israel also with you into the hand of the Philistines; and tomorrow you and your sons will be with me. Yahweh will deliver the army of Israel also into the hand of the Philistines."
20 Then Saul fell immediately his full length on the earth, and was terrified, because of Samuel's words. There was no strength in him, for he had eaten no bread all day long or all night long.
21 The woman came to Saul and saw that he was very troubled, and said to him, "Behold, your servant has listened to your voice, and I have put my life in my hand, and have listened to your words which you spoke to me.
22 Now therefore, please listen also to the voice of your servant, and let me set a morsel of bread before you. Eat, that you may have strength when you go on your way."
23 But he refused, and said, "I will not eat." But his servants, together with the woman, constrained him; and he listened to their voice. So he arose from the earth and sat on the bed.
24 The woman had a fattened calf in the house. She hurried and killed it; and she took flour and kneaded it, and baked unleavened bread of it.
25 She brought it before Saul and before his servants, and they ate. Then they rose up and went away that night.

29

1 Now the Philistines gathered together
all their armies to Aphek; and the
Israelites encamped by the spring which
is in Jezreel.
2 The lords of the Philistines passed on
by hundreds and by thousands; and David
and his men passed on in the rear with
Achish.
3 Then the princes of the Philistines
said, "What about these Hebrews?"
Achish said to the princes of the
Philistines, "Isn't this David, the servant of
Saul the king of Israel, who has been with
me these days, or rather these years? I
have found no fault in him since he fell
away until today."
4 But the princes of the Philistines were
angry with him; and the princes of the
Philistines said to him, "Make the man
return, that he may go back to his place
where you have appointed him, and let
him not go down with us to battle, lest in
the battle he become an adversary to us.
For with what should this fellow reconcile
himself to his lord? Should it not be with
the heads of these men?
5 Isn't this David, of whom people sang
to one another in dances, saying,
'Saul has slain his thousands,
and David his ten thousands'?"
6 Then Achish called David and said to
him, "As Yahweh lives, you have been
upright, and your going out and your
coming in with me in the army is good in
my sight; for I have not found evil in you
since the day of your coming to me to this
day. Nevertheless, the lords don't favor
you.
7 Therefore now return, and go in
peace, that you not displease the lords of
the Philistines."
8 David said to Achish, "But what have I
done? What have you found in your
servant so long as I have been before you
to this day, that I may not go and fight
against the enemies of my lord the king?"
9 Achish answered David, "I know that
you are good in my sight, as an angel of
God. Notwithstanding, the princes of the
Philistines have said, 'He shall not go up
with us to the battle.'
10 Therefore now rise up early in the
morning with the servants of your lord
who have come with you; and as soon as
you are up early in the morning and have
light, depart."
11 So David rose up early, he and his
men, to depart in the morning, to return
into the land of the Philistines; and the
Philistines went up to Jezreel.

30

1 When David and his men had come to
Ziklag on the third day, the Amalekites
had made a raid on the South and on
Ziklag, and had struck Ziklag and burned
it with fire,
2 and had taken captive the women and
all who were in it, both small and great.
They didn't kill any, but carried them off
and went their way.
3 When David and his men came to the
city, behold, it was burned with fire; and
their wives, their sons, and their
daughters were taken captive.
4 Then David and the people who were
with him lifted up their voice and wept
until they had no more power to weep.
5 David's two wives were taken captive,
Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the
wife of Nabal the Carmelite.
6 David was greatly distressed, for the
people spoke of stoning him, because the
souls of all the people were grieved, every
man for his sons and for his daughters;
but David strengthened himself in
Yahweh his God.
7 David said to Abiathar the priest, the
son of Ahimelech, "Please bring the ephod
here to me."
Abiathar brought the ephod to David.
8 David inquired of Yahweh, saying, "If I
pursue after this troop, will I overtake
them?"
He answered him, "Pursue, for you will
surely overtake them, and will without
fail recover all."
9 So David went, he and the six hundred
men who were with him, and came to the
brook Besor, where those who were left
behind stayed.
10 But David pursued, he and four
hundred men; for two hundred stayed

behind, who were so faint that they couldn't go over the brook Besor.
11 They found an Egyptian in the field, and brought him to David, and gave him bread, and he ate; and they gave him water to drink.
12 They gave him a piece of a cake of figs and two clusters of raisins. When he had eaten, his spirit came again to him; for he had eaten no bread, and drank no water for three days and three nights.
13 David asked him, "To whom do you belong? Where are you from?"
He said, "I am a young man of Egypt, servant to an Amalekite; and my master left me, because three days ago I got sick.
14 We made a raid on the South of the Cherethites, and on that which belongs to Judah, and on the South of Caleb; and we burned Ziklag with fire."
15 David said to him, "Will you bring me down to this troop?"
He said, "Swear to me by God that you will not kill me and not deliver me up into the hands of my master, and I will bring you down to this troop."
16 When he had brought him down, behold, they were spread around over all the ground, eating, drinking, and dancing, because of all the great plunder that they had taken out of the land of the Philistines, and out of the land of Judah.
17 David struck them from the twilight even to the evening of the next day. Not a man of them escaped from there, except four hundred young men who rode on camels and fled.
18 David recovered all that the Amalekites had taken, and David rescued his two wives.
19 There was nothing lacking to them, neither small nor great, neither sons nor daughters, neither plunder, nor anything that they had taken. David brought them all back.
20 David took all the flocks and the herds, which they drove before those other livestock, and said, "This is David's plunder."
21 David came to the two hundred men, who were so faint that they could not follow David, whom also they had made to stay at the brook Besor; and they went out to meet David, and to meet the people who were with him. When David came near to the people, he greeted them.
22 Then all the wicked men and worthless fellows of those who went with David answered and said, "Because they didn't go with us, we will not give them anything of the plunder that we have recovered, except to every man his wife and his children, that he may lead them away and depart."
23 Then David said, "Do not do so, my brothers, with that which Yahweh has given to us, who has preserved us, and delivered the troop that came against us into our hand.
24 Who will listen to you in this matter? For as his share is who goes down to the battle, so shall his share be who stays with the baggage. They shall share alike."
25 It was so from that day forward that he made it a statute and an ordinance for Israel to this day.
26 When David came to Ziklag, he sent some of the plunder to the elders of Judah, even to his friends, saying, "Behold, a present for you from the plunder of Yahweh's enemies."
27 He sent it to those who were in Bethel, to those who were in Ramoth of the South, to those who were in Jattir,
28 to those who were in Aroer, to those who were in Siphmoth, to those who were in Eshtemoa,
29 to those who were in Racal, to those who were in the cities of the Jerahmeelites, to those who were in the cities of the Kenites,
30 to those who were in Hormah, to those who were in Borashan, to those who were in Athach,
31 to those who were in Hebron, and to all the places where David himself and his men used to stay.

31

1 Now the Philistines fought against Israel; and the men of Israel fled from before the Philistines, and fell down slain on Mount Gilboa.
2 The Philistines overtook Saul and his sons; and the Philistines killed Jonathan,

Abinadab, and Malchishua, the sons of
Saul.
3 The battle went hard against Saul, and
the archers overtook him; and he was
greatly distressed by reason of the
archers.
4 Then Saul said to his armor bearer,
“Draw your sword, and thrust me through
with it, lest these uncircumcised come
and thrust me through and abuse me!”
But his armor bearer would not, for he
was terrified. Therefore Saul took his
sword and fell on it.
5 When his armor bearer saw that Saul
was dead, he likewise fell on his sword,
and died with him.
6 So Saul died with his three sons, his
armor bearer, and all his men that same
day together.
7 When the men of Israel who were on
the other side of the valley, and those who
were beyond the Jordan, saw that the men
of Israel fled and that Saul and his sons
were dead, they abandoned the cities and
fled; and the Philistines came and lived in
them.
8 On the next day, when the Philistines
came to strip the slain, they found Saul
and his three sons fallen on Mount Gilboa.
9 They cut off his head, stripped off his
armor, and sent into the land of the
Philistines all around, to carry the news to
the house of their idols and to the people.
10 They put his armor in the house of the
Ashtaroth, and they fastened his body to
the wall of Beth Shan.
11 When the inhabitants of Jabesh
Gilead heard what the Philistines had
done to Saul,
12 all the valiant men arose, went all
night, and took the body of Saul and the
bodies of his sons from the wall of Beth
Shan; and they came to Jabesh and
burned them there.
13 They took their bones and buried
them under the tamarisk† tree in Jabesh,
and fasted seven days.

† **31:13** or, salt cedar

The Second Book of Samuel

1 After the death of Saul, when David
had returned from the slaughter of the
Amalekites, and David had stayed two
days in Ziklag,
2 on the third day, behold,† a man came
out of the camp from Saul, with his
clothes torn and earth on his head. When
he came to David, he fell to the earth and
showed respect.
3 David said to him, "Where do you
come from?"
He said to him, "I have escaped out of
the camp of Israel."
4 David said to him, "How did it go?
Please tell me."
He answered, "The people have fled
from the battle, and many of the people
also have fallen and are dead. Saul and
Jonathan his son are dead also."
5 David said to the young man who told
him, "How do you know that Saul and
Jonathan his son are dead?"
6 The young man who told him said, "As
I happened by chance on Mount Gilboa,
behold, Saul was leaning on his spear; and
behold, the chariots and the horsemen
followed close behind him.
7 When he looked behind him, he saw
me and called to me. I answered, 'Here I
am.'
8 He said to me, 'Who are you?' I
answered him, 'I am an Amalekite.'
9 He said to me, 'Please stand beside me,
and kill me, for anguish has taken hold of
me because my life lingers in me.'
10 So I stood beside him and killed him,
because I was sure that he could not live
after he had fallen. I took the crown that
was on his head and the bracelet that was
on his arm, and have brought them here
to my lord."
11 Then David took hold on his clothes
and tore them; and all the men who were
with him did likewise.
12 They mourned, wept, and fasted until
evening for Saul and for Jonathan his son,
and for the people of Yahweh,‡ and for the
house of Israel, because they had fallen by
the sword.
13 David said to the young man who told
him, "Where are you from?"
He answered, "I am the son of a
foreigner, an Amalekite."
14 David said to him, "Why were you not
afraid to stretch out your hand to destroy
Yahweh's anointed?"
15 David called one of the young men
and said, "Go near, and cut him down!"
He struck him so that he died.
16 David said to him, "Your blood be on
your head, for your mouth has testified
against you, saying, 'I have slain Yahweh's
anointed.' "
17 David lamented with this lamentation
over Saul and over Jonathan his son
18 (and he commanded them to teach
the children of Judah the song of the bow;
behold, it is written in the book of Jashar):
19 "Your glory, Israel, was slain on your
high places!
How the mighty have fallen!
20 Don't tell it in Gath.
Don't publish it in the streets of
Ashkelon,
lest the daughters of the Philistines
rejoice,
lest the daughters of the
uncircumcised triumph.
21 You mountains of Gilboa,
let there be no dew or rain on you,
and no fields of offerings;
for there the shield of the mighty was
defiled and cast away,
the shield of Saul was not anointed
with oil.
22 From the blood of the slain,
from the fat of the mighty,
Jonathan's bow didn't turn back.
Saul's sword didn't return empty.
23 Saul and Jonathan were lovely and
pleasant in their lives.
In their death, they were not divided.
They were swifter than eagles.
They were stronger than lions.
24 You daughters of Israel, weep over Saul,
who clothed you delicately in scarlet,

† **1:2** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
‡ **1:12** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations.

who put ornaments of gold on your
clothing.
25 How the mighty have fallen in the
middle of the battle!
Jonathan was slain on your high
places.
26 I am distressed for you, my brother
Jonathan.
You have been very pleasant to me.
Your love to me was wonderful,
surpassing the love of women.
27 How the mighty have fallen,
and the weapons of war have
perished!"

2

1 After this, David inquired of Yahweh, saying, "Shall I go up into any of the cities of Judah?"
Yahweh said to him, "Go up."
David said, "Where shall I go up?"
He said, "To Hebron."
2 So David went up there with his two wives, Ahinoam the Jezreelitess, and Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite.
3 David brought up his men who were with him, every man with his household. They lived in the cities of Hebron.
4 The men of Judah came, and there they anointed David king over the house of Judah. They told David, "The men of Jabesh Gilead were those who buried Saul."
5 David sent messengers to the men of Jabesh Gilead, and said to them, "Blessed are you by Yahweh, that you have shown this kindness to your lord, even to Saul, and have buried him.
6 Now may Yahweh show loving kindness and truth to you. I also will reward you for this kindness, because you have done this thing.
7 Now therefore let your hands be strong, and be valiant; for Saul your lord is dead, and also the house of Judah have anointed me king over them."
8 Now Abner the son of Ner, captain of Saul's army, had taken Ishbosheth the son of Saul and brought him over to Mahanaim.
9 He made him king over Gilead, over the Ashurites, over Jezreel, over Ephraim, over Benjamin, and over all Israel.
10 Ishbosheth, Saul's son, was forty years old when he began to reign over Israel, and he reigned two years. But the house of Judah followed David.
11 The time that David was king in Hebron over the house of Judah was seven years and six months.
12 Abner the son of Ner, and the servants of Ishbosheth the son of Saul, went out from Mahanaim to Gibeon.
13 Joab the son of Zeruiah and David's servants went out, and met them by the pool of Gibeon; and they sat down, the one on the one side of the pool and the other on the other side of the pool.
14 Abner said to Joab, "Please let the young men arise and compete before us!"
Joab said, "Let them arise!"
15 Then they arose and went over by number: twelve for Benjamin and for Ishbosheth the son of Saul, and twelve of David's servants.
16 They each caught his opponent by the head and thrust his sword in his fellow's side; so they fell down together. Therefore that place in Gibeon was called Helkath Hazzurim.†
17 The battle was very severe that day; and Abner was beaten, and the men of Israel, before David's servants.
18 The three sons of Zeruiah were there: Joab, Abishai, and Asahel. Asahel was as light of foot as a wild gazelle.
19 Asahel pursued Abner. He didn't turn to the right hand or to the left from following Abner.
20 Then Abner looked behind him and said, "Is that you, Asahel?"
He answered, "It is."
21 Abner said to him, "Turn away to your right hand or to your left, and grab one of the young men, and take his armor." But Asahel would not turn away from following him.
22 Abner said again to Asahel, "Turn away from following me. Why should I

† **2:16** "Helkath Hazzurim" means "field of daggers".

strike you to the ground? How then could I look Joab your brother in the face?"
23 However, he refused to turn away. Therefore Abner with the back end of the spear struck him in the body, so that the spear came out behind him; and he fell down there and died in the same place. As many as came to the place where Asahel fell down and died stood still.
24 But Joab and Abishai pursued Abner. The sun went down when they had come to the hill of Ammah, that lies before Giah by the way of the wilderness of Gibeon.
25 The children of Benjamin gathered themselves together after Abner and became one band, and stood on the top of a hill.
26 Then Abner called to Joab, and said, "Shall the sword devour forever? Don't you know that it will be bitterness in the latter end? How long will it be then, before you ask the people to return from following their brothers?"
27 Joab said, "As God‡ lives, if you had not spoken, surely then in the morning the people would have gone away, and not each followed his brother."
28 So Joab blew the trumpet; and all the people stood still and pursued Israel no more, and they fought no more.
29 Abner and his men went all that night through the Arabah; and they passed over the Jordan, and went through all Bithron, and came to Mahanaim.
30 Joab returned from following Abner; and when he had gathered all the people together, nineteen men of David's and Asahel were missing.
31 But David's servants had struck Benjamin Abner's men so that three hundred sixty men died.
32 They took up Asahel and buried him in the tomb of his father, which was in Bethlehem. Joab and his men went all night, and the day broke on them at Hebron.

3

1 Now there was long war between Saul's house and David's house. David grew stronger and stronger, but Saul's house grew weaker and weaker.
2 Sons were born to David in Hebron. His firstborn was Amnon, of Ahinoam the Jezreelitess;
3 and his second, Chileab, of Abigail the wife of Nabal the Carmelite; and the third, Absalom the son of Maacah the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur;
4 and the fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith; and the fifth, Shephatiah the son of Abital;
5 and the sixth, Ithream, of Eglah, David's wife. These were born to David in Hebron.
6 While there was war between Saul's house and David's house, Abner made himself strong in Saul's house.
7 Now Saul had a concubine, whose name was Rizpah, the daughter of Aiah; and Ishbosheth said to Abner, "Why have you gone in to my father's concubine?"
8 Then Abner was very angry about Ishbosheth's words, and said, "Am I a dog's head that belongs to Judah? Today I show kindness to your father Saul's house, to his brothers, and to his friends, and have not delivered you into the hand of David; and yet you charge me today with a fault concerning this woman!
9 God do so to Abner, and more also, if, as Yahweh has sworn to David, I don't do even so to him:
10 to transfer the kingdom from Saul's house, and to set up David's throne over Israel and over Judah, from Dan even to Beersheba."
11 He could not answer Abner another word, because he was afraid of him.
12 Abner sent messengers to David on his behalf, saying, "Whose is the land?" and saying, "Make your alliance with me, and behold, my hand will be with you to bring all Israel around to you."
13 David said, "Good. I will make a treaty with you, but one thing I require of you. That is, you will not see my face unless you first bring Michal, Saul's daughter, when you come to see my face."
14 David sent messengers to Ishbosheth, Saul's son, saying, "Deliver me my wife

‡ **2:27** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

Michal, whom I was given to marry for one hundred foreskins of the Philistines."
15 Ishbosheth sent and took her from her husband, Paltiel the son of Laish.
16 Her husband went with her, weeping as he went, and followed her to Bahurim. Then Abner said to him, "Go! Return!" and he returned.
17 Abner had communication with the elders of Israel, saying, "In times past, you sought for David to be king over you.
18 Now then do it! For Yahweh has spoken of David, saying, 'By the hand of my servant David, I will save my people Israel out of the hand of the Philistines, and out of the hand of all their enemies.' "
19 Abner also spoke in the ears of Benjamin; and Abner went also to speak in the ears of David in Hebron all that seemed good to Israel and to the whole house of Benjamin.
20 So Abner came to David to Hebron, and twenty men with him. David made Abner and the men who were with him a feast.
21 Abner said to David, "I will arise and go, and will gather all Israel to my lord the king, that they may make a covenant with you, and that you may reign over all that your soul desires." David sent Abner away; and he went in peace.
22 Behold, David's servants and Joab came from a raid and brought in a great plunder with them; but Abner was not with David in Hebron, for he had sent him away, and he had gone in peace.
23 When Joab and all the army who was with him had come, they told Joab, "Abner the son of Ner came to the king, and he has sent him away, and he has gone in peace."
24 Then Joab came to the king and said, "What have you done? Behold, Abner came to you. Why is it that you have sent him away, and he is already gone?
25 You know Abner the son of Ner. He came to deceive you, and to know your going out and your coming in, and to know all that you do."
26 When Joab had come out from David, he sent messengers after Abner, and they brought him back from the well of Sirah; but David didn't know it.
27 When Abner had returned to Hebron, Joab took him aside into the middle of the gate to speak with him quietly, and struck him there in the body, so that he died for the blood of Asahel his brother.
28 Afterward, when David heard it, he said, "I and my kingdom are guiltless before Yahweh forever of the blood of Abner the son of Ner.
29 Let it fall on the head of Joab and on all his father's house. Let there not fail from the house of Joab one who has a discharge, or who is a leper, or who leans on a staff, or who falls by the sword, or who lacks bread."
30 So Joab and Abishai his brother killed Abner, because he had killed their brother Asahel at Gibeon in the battle.
31 David said to Joab and to all the people who were with him, "Tear your clothes, and clothe yourselves with sackcloth, and mourn in front of Abner." King David followed the bier.
32 They buried Abner in Hebron; and the king lifted up his voice and wept at Abner's grave; and all the people wept.
33 The king lamented for Abner, and said, "Should Abner die as a fool dies?
34 Your hands weren't bound, and your feet weren't put into fetters. As a man falls before the children of iniquity, so you fell."
All the people wept again over him.
35 All the people came to urge David to eat bread while it was yet day; but David swore, saying, "God do so to me, and more also, if I taste bread or anything else, until the sun goes down."
36 All the people took notice of it, and it pleased them, as whatever the king did pleased all the people.
37 So all the people and all Israel understood that day that it was not of the king to kill Abner the son of Ner.
38 The king said to his servants, "Don't you know that a prince and a great man has fallen today in Israel?
39 I am weak today, though anointed king. These men, the sons of Zeruiah are too hard for me. May Yahweh reward the evildoer according to his wickedness."

4

1 When Saul's son heard that Abner was
dead in Hebron, his hands became feeble,
and all the Israelites were troubled.
2 Saul's son had two men who were
captains of raiding bands. The name of
one was Baanah and the name of the
other Rechab, the sons of Rimmon the
Beerothite, of the children of Benjamin
(for Beeroth also is considered a part of
Benjamin;
3 and the Beerothites fled to Gittaim,
and have lived as foreigners there until
today).

4 Now Jonathan, Saul's son, had a son
who was lame in his feet. He was five
years old when the news came about Saul
and Jonathan out of Jezreel; and his nurse
picked him up and fled. As she hurried to
flee, he fell and became lame. His name
was Mephibosheth.

5 The sons of Rimmon the Beerothite,
Rechab and Baanah, went out and came
at about the heat of the day to the house of
Ishbosheth as he took his rest at noon.
6 They came there into the middle of the
house as though they would have fetched
wheat, and they struck him in the body;
and Rechab and Baanah his brother
escaped.
7 Now when they came into the house as
he lay on his bed in his bedroom, they
struck him, killed him, beheaded him, and
took his head, and went by the way of the
Arabah all night.
8 They brought the head of Ishbosheth
to David to Hebron, and said to the king,
"Behold, the head of Ishbosheth, the son
of Saul, your enemy, who sought your life!
Yahweh has avenged my lord the king
today of Saul and of his offspring.[†]"

9 David answered Rechab and Baanah
his brother, the sons of Rimmon the
Beerothite, and said to them, "As Yahweh
lives, who has redeemed my soul out of all
adversity,
10 when someone told me, 'Behold, Saul
is dead,' thinking that he brought good
news, I seized him and killed him in
Ziklag, which was the reward I gave him
for his news.
11 How much more, when wicked men
have slain a righteous person in his own
house on his bed, should I not now
require his blood from your hand, and rid
the earth of you?"
12 David commanded his young men,
and they killed them, cut off their hands
and their feet, and hanged them up beside
the pool in Hebron. But they took the
head of Ishbosheth and buried it in
Abner's grave in Hebron.

5

1 Then all the tribes of Israel came to
David at Hebron and spoke, saying,
"Behold, we are your bone and your flesh.
2 In times past, when Saul was king over
us, it was you who led Israel out and in.
Yahweh said to you, 'You will be shepherd
of my people Israel, and you will be prince
over Israel.' "
3 So all the elders of Israel came to the
king to Hebron, and King David made a
covenant with them in Hebron before
Yahweh; and they anointed David king
over Israel.
4 David was thirty years old when he
began to reign, and he reigned forty years.
5 In Hebron he reigned over Judah
seven years and six months, and in
Jerusalem he reigned thirty-three years
over all Israel and Judah.
6 The king and his men went to
Jerusalem against the Jebusites, the
inhabitants of the land, who spoke to
David, saying, "The blind and the lame
will keep you out of here," thinking,
"David can't come in here."
7 Nevertheless David took the
stronghold of Zion. This is David's city.
8 David said on that day, "Whoever
strikes the Jebusites, let him go up to the
watercourse and strike those lame and
blind, who are hated by David's soul."
Therefore they say, "The blind and the
lame can't come into the house."
9 David lived in the stronghold, and
called it David's city. David built around
from Millo and inward.
10 David grew greater and greater, for
Yahweh, the God of Armies, was with him.

[†] **4:8** or, seed

11 Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers
to David, with cedar trees, carpenters,
and masons; and they built David a house.
12 David perceived that Yahweh had
established him king over Israel, and that
he had exalted his kingdom for his people
Israel's sake.
13 David took more concubines and
wives for himself out of Jerusalem, after
he had come from Hebron; and more sons
and daughters were born to David.
14 These are the names of those who
were born to him in Jerusalem:
Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon,
15 Ibhar, Elishua, Nepheg, Japhia,
16 Elishama, Eliada, and Eliphelet.
17 When the Philistines heard that they
had anointed David king over Israel, all
the Philistines went up to seek David, but
David heard about it and went down to
the stronghold.
18 Now the Philistines had come and
spread themselves in the valley of
Rephaim.
19 David inquired of Yahweh, saying,
"Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will
you deliver them into my hand?"
Yahweh said to David, "Go up; for I will
certainly deliver the Philistines into your
hand."
20 David came to Baal Perazim, and
David struck them there. Then he said,
"Yahweh has broken my enemies before
me, like the breach of waters." Therefore
he called the name of that place Baal
Perazim.†
21 They left their images there, and
David and his men took them away.
22 The Philistines came up yet again and
spread themselves in the valley of
Rephaim.
23 When David inquired of Yahweh, he
said, "You shall not go up. Circle around
behind them, and attack them in front of
the mulberry trees.
24 When you hear the sound of
marching in the tops of the mulberry
trees, then stir yourself up; for then
Yahweh has gone out before you to strike
the army of the Philistines."
25 David did so, as Yahweh commanded
him, and struck the Philistines all the way
from Geba to Gezer.

6

1 David again gathered together all the
chosen men of Israel, thirty thousand.
2 David arose and went with all the
people who were with him from Baale
Judah, to bring up from there God's ark,
which is called by the Name, even the
name of Yahweh of Armies who sits above
the cherubim.
3 They set God's ark on a new cart, and
brought it out of Abinadab's house that
was on the hill; and Uzzah and Ahio, the
sons of Abinadab, drove the new cart.
4 They brought it out of Abinadab's
house which was in the hill, with God's
ark; and Ahio went before the ark.
5 David and all the house of Israel
played before Yahweh with all kinds of
instruments made of cypress wood, with
harps, with stringed instruments, with
tambourines, with castanets, and with
cymbals.
6 When they came to the threshing floor
of Nacon, Uzzah reached for God's ark
and took hold of it, for the cattle stumbled.
7 Yahweh's anger burned against Uzzah,
and God struck him there for his error;
and he died there by God's ark.
8 David was displeased because Yahweh
had broken out against Uzzah; and he
called that place Perez Uzzah† to this day.
9 David was afraid of Yahweh that day;
and he said, "How could Yahweh's ark
come to me?"
10 So David would not move Yahweh's
ark to be with him in David's city; but
David carried it aside into Obed-Edom the
Gittite's house.
11 Yahweh's ark remained in
Obed-Edom the Gittite's house three
months; and Yahweh blessed Obed-Edom
and all his house.
12 King David was told, "Yahweh has
blessed the house of Obed-Edom, and all
that belongs to him, because of God's ark."
So David went and brought up God's
ark from the house of Obed-Edom into
David's city with joy.

† **5:20** "Baal Perazim" means "Lord who breaks out".

† **6:8** "Perez Uzzah" means "outbreak against Uzzah".

13 When those who bore Yahweh's ark had gone six paces, he sacrificed an ox and a fattened calf.
14 David danced before Yahweh with all his might; and David was clothed in a linen ephod.
15 So David and all the house of Israel brought up Yahweh's ark with shouting and with the sound of the trumpet.
16 As Yahweh's ark came into David's city, Michal the daughter of Saul looked out through the window and saw King David leaping and dancing before Yahweh; and she despised him in her heart.
17 They brought in Yahweh's ark, and set it in its place in the middle of the tent that David had pitched for it; and David offered burnt offerings and peace offerings before Yahweh.
18 When David had finished offering the burnt offering and the peace offerings, he blessed the people in the name of Yahweh of Armies.
19 He gave to all the people, even among the whole multitude of Israel, both to men and women, to everyone a portion of bread, dates, and raisins. So all the people departed, each to his own house.
20 Then David returned to bless his household. Michal the daughter of Saul came out to meet David, and said, "How glorious the king of Israel was today, who uncovered himself today in the eyes of his servants' maids, as one of the vain fellows shamelessly uncovers himself!"
21 David said to Michal, "It was before Yahweh, who chose me above your father, and above all his house, to appoint me prince over the people of Yahweh, over Israel. Therefore I will celebrate before Yahweh.
22 I will be yet more undignified than this, and will be worthless in my own sight. But the maids of whom you have spoken will honor me."
23 Michal the daughter of Saul had no child to the day of her death.

7

1 When the king lived in his house, and Yahweh had given him rest from all his enemies all around,
2 the king said to Nathan the prophet, "See now, I dwell in a house of cedar, but God's ark dwells within curtains."
3 Nathan said to the king, "Go, do all that is in your heart, for Yahweh is with you."
4 That same night, Yahweh's word came to Nathan, saying,
5 "Go and tell my servant David, 'Yahweh says, "Should you build me a house for me to dwell in?
6 For I have not lived in a house since the day that I brought the children of Israel up out of Egypt, even to this day, but have moved around in a tent and in a tabernacle.
7 In all places in which I have walked with all the children of Israel, did I say a word to anyone from the tribes of Israel whom I commanded to be shepherd of my people Israel, saying, 'Why have you not built me a house of cedar?' " '
8 Now therefore tell my servant David this: 'Yahweh of Armies says, "I took you from the sheep pen, from following the sheep, to be prince over my people, over Israel.
9 I have been with you wherever you went, and have cut off all your enemies from before you. I will make you a great name, like the name of the great ones who are in the earth.
10 I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in their own place and be moved no more. The children of wickedness will not afflict them any more, as at the first,
11 and as from the day that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel. I will cause you to rest from all your enemies. Moreover Yahweh tells you that Yahweh will make you a house.
12 When your days are fulfilled and you sleep with your fathers, I will set up your offspring after you, who will proceed out of your body, and I will establish his kingdom.
13 He will build a house for my name, and I will establish the throne of his kingdom forever.
14 I will be his father, and he will be my son. If he commits iniquity, I will chasten

him with the rod of men and with the stripes of the children of men;
15 but my loving kindness will not depart from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I put away before you.
16 Your house and your kingdom will be made sure forever before you. Your throne will be established forever.” ’ ”
17 Nathan spoke to David all these words, and according to all this vision.
18 Then David the king went in and sat before Yahweh; and he said, “Who am I, Lord† Yahweh, and what is my house, that you have brought me this far?
19 This was yet a small thing in your eyes, Lord Yahweh, but you have spoken also of your servant’s house for a great while to come; and this among men, Lord Yahweh!
20 What more can David say to you? For you know your servant, Lord Yahweh.
21 For your word’s sake, and according to your own heart, you have worked all this greatness, to make your servant know it.
22 Therefore you are great, Yahweh God. For there is no one like you, neither is there any God besides you, according to all that we have heard with our ears.
23 What one nation in the earth is like your people, even like Israel, whom God went to redeem to himself for a people, and to make himself a name, and to do great things for you, and awesome things for your land, before your people, whom you redeemed to yourself out of Egypt, from the nations and their gods?
24 You established for yourself your people Israel to be your people forever; and you, Yahweh, became their God.
25 “Now, Yahweh God, the word that you have spoken concerning your servant, and concerning his house, confirm it forever, and do as you have spoken.
26 Let your name be magnified forever, saying, ‘Yahweh of Armies is God over Israel; and the house of your servant David will be established before you.’
27 For you, Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, have revealed to your servant, saying, ‘I will build you a house.’ Therefore your servant has found in his heart to pray this prayer to you.
28 “Now, O Lord Yahweh, you are God, and your words are truth, and you have promised this good thing to your servant.
29 Now therefore, let it please you to bless the house of your servant, that it may continue forever before you; for you, Lord Yahweh, have spoken it. Let the house of your servant be blessed forever with your blessing.”

8

1 After this, David struck the Philistines and subdued them; and David took the bridle of the mother city out of the hand of the Philistines.
2 He defeated Moab, and measured them with the line, making them to lie down on the ground; and he measured two lines to put to death, and one full line to keep alive. The Moabites became servants to David, and brought tribute.
3 David also struck Hadadezer the son of Rehob, king of Zobah, as he went to recover his dominion at the River.
4 David took from him one thousand seven hundred horsemen and twenty thousand footmen. David hamstrung the chariot horses, but reserved enough of them for one hundred chariots.
5 When the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadadezer king of Zobah, David struck twenty two thousand men of the Syrians.
6 Then David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus; and the Syrians became servants to David, and brought tribute. Yahweh gave victory to David wherever he went.
7 David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadadezer, and brought them to Jerusalem.
8 From Betah and from Berothai, cities of Hadadezer, King David took a great quantity of bronze.
9 When Toi king of Hamath heard that David had struck all the army of Hadadezer,

† **7:18** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai.”

10 then Toi sent Joram his son to King
David to greet him and to bless him,
because he had fought against Hadadezer
and struck him; for Hadadezer had wars
with Toi. Joram brought with him vessels
of silver, vessels of gold, and vessels of
bronze.
11 King David also dedicated these to
Yahweh, with the silver and gold that he
dedicated of all the nations which he
subdued—
12 of Syria, of Moab, of the children of
Ammon, of the Philistines, of Amalek, and
of the plunder of Hadadezer, son of
Rehob, king of Zobah.
13 David earned a reputation when he
returned from striking down eighteen
thousand men of the Syrians in the Valley
of Salt.
14 He put garrisons in Edom.
Throughout all Edom, he put garrisons,
and all the Edomites became servants to
David. Yahweh gave victory to David
wherever he went.
15 David reigned over all Israel; and
David executed justice and righteousness
for all his people.
16 Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the
army, Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was
recorder,
17 Zadok the son of Ahitub and
Ahimelech the son of Abiathar were
priests, Seraiah was scribe,
18 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over
the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and
David's sons were chief ministers.

9

1 David said, "Is there yet any who is left
of Saul's house, that I may show him
kindness for Jonathan's sake?"
2 There was of Saul's house a servant
whose name was Ziba, and they called
him to David; and the king said to him,
"Are you Ziba?"
He said, "I am your servant."
3 The king said, "Is there not yet any of
Saul's house, that I may show the
kindness of God to him?"
Ziba said to the king, "Jonathan still has
a son, who is lame in his feet."
4 The king said to him, "Where is he?"
Ziba said to the king, "Behold, he is in
the house of Machir the son of Ammiel, in
Lo Debar."
5 Then King David sent and brought him
out of the house of Machir the son of
Ammiel, from Lo Debar.
6 Mephibosheth, the son of Jonathan,
the son of Saul, came to David, fell on his
face, and showed respect. David said,
"Mephibosheth?"
He answered, "Behold, your servant!"
7 David said to him, "Don't be afraid, for
I will surely show you kindness for
Jonathan your father's sake, and will
restore to you all the land of Saul your
father. You will eat bread at my table
continually."
8 He bowed down, and said, "What is
your servant, that you should look at such
a dead dog as I am?"
9 Then the king called to Ziba, Saul's
servant, and said to him, "All that
belonged to Saul and to all his house I
have given to your master's son.
10 Till the land for him—you, your sons,
and your servants. Bring in the harvest,
that your master's son may have bread to
eat; but Mephibosheth your master's son
will always eat bread at my table."
Now Ziba had fifteen sons and twenty
servants.
11 Then Ziba said to the king, "According
to all that my lord the king commands his
servant, so your servant will do." So
Mephibosheth ate at the king's table like
one of the king's sons.
12 Mephibosheth had a young son,
whose name was Mica. All who lived in
Ziba's house were servants to
Mephibosheth.
13 So Mephibosheth lived in Jerusalem,
for he ate continually at the king's table.
He was lame in both his feet.

10

1 After this, the king of the children of
Ammon died, and Hanun his son reigned
in his place.
2 David said, "I will show kindness to
Hanun the son of Nahash, as his father
showed kindness to me." So David sent by
his servants to comfort him concerning

his father. David's servants came into the land of the children of Ammon.
3 But the princes of the children of Ammon said to Hanun their lord, "Do you think that David honors your father, in that he has sent comforters to you? Hasn't David sent his servants to you to search the city, to spy it out, and to overthrow it?"
4 So Hanun took David's servants, shaved off one half of their beards, and cut off their garments in the middle, even to their buttocks, and sent them away.
5 When they told David this, he sent to meet them, for the men were greatly ashamed. The king said, "Wait at Jericho until your beards have grown, and then return."
6 When the children of Ammon saw that they had become odious to David, the children of Ammon sent and hired the Syrians of Beth Rehob and the Syrians of Zobah, twenty thousand footmen, and the king of Maacah with one thousand men, and the men of Tob twelve thousand men.
7 When David heard of it, he sent Joab and all the army of the mighty men.
8 The children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array at the entrance of the gate. The Syrians of Zobah and of Rehob and the men of Tob and Maacah were by themselves in the field.
9 Now when Joab saw that the battle was set against him before and behind, he chose of all the choice men of Israel and put them in array against the Syrians.
10 The rest of the people he committed into the hand of Abishai his brother; and he put them in array against the children of Ammon.
11 He said, "If the Syrians are too strong for me, then you shall help me; but if the children of Ammon are too strong for you, then I will come and help you.
12 Be courageous, and let's be strong for our people and for the cities of our God; and may Yahweh do what seems good to him."
13 So Joab and the people who were with him came near to the battle against the Syrians, and they fled before him.
14 When the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians had fled, they likewise fled before Abishai, and entered into the city. Then Joab returned from the children of Ammon and came to Jerusalem.
15 When the Syrians saw that they were defeated by Israel, they gathered themselves together.
16 Hadadezer sent and brought out the Syrians who were beyond the River; and they came to Helam, with Shobach the captain of the army of Hadadezer at their head.
17 David was told that; and he gathered all Israel together, passed over the Jordan, and came to Helam. The Syrians set themselves in array against David and fought with him.
18 The Syrians fled before Israel; and David killed seven hundred charioteers of the Syrians and forty thousand horsemen, and struck Shobach the captain of their army, so that he died there.
19 When all the kings who were servants to Hadadezer saw that they were defeated before Israel, they made peace with Israel and served them. So the Syrians were afraid to help the children of Ammon any more.

11

1 At the return of the year, at the time when kings go out, David sent Joab and his servants with him, and all Israel; and they destroyed the children of Ammon and besieged Rabbah. But David stayed at Jerusalem.
2 At evening, David arose from his bed and walked on the roof of the king's house. From the roof, he saw a woman bathing, and the woman was very beautiful to look at.
3 David sent and inquired after the woman. One said, "Isn't this Bathsheba, the daughter of Eliam, Uriah the Hittite's wife?"
4 David sent messengers, and took her; and she came in to him, and he lay with her (for she was purified from her uncleanness); and she returned to her house.
5 The woman conceived; and she sent and told David, and said, "I am with child."

6 David sent to Joab, “Send me Uriah the
Hittite.” Joab sent Uriah to David.
7 When Uriah had come to him, David
asked him how Joab did, and how the
people fared, and how the war prospered.
8 David said to Uriah, “Go down to your
house and wash your feet.” Uriah
departed out of the king’s house, and a gift
from the king was sent after him.
9 But Uriah slept at the door of the king’s
house with all the servants of his lord, and
didn’t go down to his house.
10 When they had told David, saying,
“Uriah didn’t go down to his house,” David
said to Uriah, “Haven’t you come from a
journey? Why didn’t you go down to your
house?”
11 Uriah said to David, “The ark, Israel,
and Judah, are staying in tents; and my
lord Joab and the servants of my lord are
encamped in the open field. Shall I then
go into my house to eat and to drink, and
to lie with my wife? As you live, and as
your soul lives, I will not do this thing!”
12 David said to Uriah, “Stay here today
also, and tomorrow I will let you depart.”
So Uriah stayed in Jerusalem that day and
the next day.
13 When David had called him, he ate
and drank before him; and he made him
drunk. At evening, he went out to lie on
his bed with the servants of his lord, but
didn’t go down to his house.
14 In the morning, David wrote a letter
to Joab and sent it by the hand of Uriah.
15 He wrote in the letter, saying, “Send
Uriah to the forefront of the hottest battle,
and retreat from him, that he may be
struck and die.”
16 When Joab kept watch on the city, he
assigned Uriah to the place where he
knew that valiant men were.
17 The men of the city went out and
fought with Joab. Some of the people fell,
even of David’s servants; and Uriah the
Hittite died also.
18 Then Joab sent and told David all the
things concerning the war;
19 and he commanded the messenger,
saying, “When you have finished telling
all the things concerning the war to the
king,
20 it shall be that, if the king’s wrath
arise, and he asks you, ‘Why did you go so
near to the city to fight? Didn’t you know
that they would shoot from the wall?
21 Who struck Abimelech the son of
Jerubbesheth? Didn’t a woman cast an
upper millstone on him from the wall, so
that he died at Thebez? Why did you go so
near the wall?’ then you shall say, ‘Your
servant Uriah the Hittite is also dead.’ ”
22 So the messenger went, and came and
showed David all that Joab had sent him
for.
23 The messenger said to David, “The
men prevailed against us, and came out to
us into the field; and we were on them
even to the entrance of the gate.
24 The shooters shot at your servants
from off the wall; and some of the king’s
servants are dead, and your servant Uriah
the Hittite is also dead.”
25 Then David said to the messenger,
“Tell Joab, ‘Don’t let this thing displease
you, for the sword devours one as well as
another. Make your battle stronger
against the city, and overthrow it.’
Encourage him.”
26 When Uriah’s wife heard that Uriah
her husband was dead, she mourned for
her husband.
27 When the mourning was past, David
sent and took her home to his house, and
she became his wife and bore him a son.
But the thing that David had done
displeased Yahweh.

12

1 Yahweh sent Nathan to David. He
came to him, and said to him, “There were
two men in one city: the one rich, and the
other poor.
2 The rich man had very many flocks
and herds,
3 but the poor man had nothing, except
one little ewe lamb, which he had bought
and raised. It grew up together with him
and with his children. It ate of his own
food, drank of his own cup, and lay in his
bosom, and was like a daughter to him.

4 A traveler came to the rich man, and
he didn't want to take of his own flock and
of his own herd to prepare for the
wayfaring man who had come to him, but
took the poor man's lamb and prepared it
for the man who had come to him."
5 David's anger burned hot against the
man, and he said to Nathan, "As Yahweh
lives, the man who has done this deserves
to die!
6 He must restore the lamb fourfold,
because he did this thing and because he
had no pity!"
7 Nathan said to David, "You are the
man! This is what Yahweh, the God of
Israel, says: 'I anointed you king over
Israel, and I delivered you out of the hand
of Saul.
8 I gave you your master's house and
your master's wives into your bosom, and
gave you the house of Israel and of Judah;
and if that would have been too little, I
would have added to you many more such
things.
9 Why have you despised Yahweh's
word, to do that which is evil in his sight?
You have struck Uriah the Hittite with the
sword, have taken his wife to be your
wife, and have slain him with the sword
of the children of Ammon.
10 Now therefore the sword will never
depart from your house, because you
have despised me and have taken Uriah
the Hittite's wife to be your wife.'
11 "This is what Yahweh says: 'Behold, I
will raise up evil against you out of your
own house; and I will take your wives
before your eyes and give them to your
neighbor, and he will lie with your wives
in the sight of this sun.
12 For you did this secretly, but I will do
this thing before all Israel, and before the
sun.' "
13 David said to Nathan, "I have sinned
against Yahweh."
Nathan said to David, "Yahweh also has
put away your sin. You will not die.
14 However, because by this deed you
have given great occasion to Yahweh's
enemies to blaspheme, the child also who
is born to you will surely die."
15 Then Nathan departed to his house.
Yahweh struck the child that Uriah's
wife bore to David, and he was very sick.
16 David therefore begged God for the
child; and David fasted, and went in and
lay all night on the ground.
17 The elders of his house arose beside
him, to raise him up from the earth; but
he would not, and he didn't eat bread with
them.
18 On the seventh day, the child died.
David's servants were afraid to tell him
that the child was dead, for they said,
"Behold, while the child was yet alive, we
spoke to him and he didn't listen to our
voice. How will he then harm himself if
we tell him that the child is dead?"
19 But when David saw that his servants
were whispering together, David
perceived that the child was dead; and
David said to his servants, "Is the child
dead?"
They said, "He is dead."
20 Then David arose from the earth, and
washed and anointed himself, and
changed his clothing; and he came into
Yahweh's house, and worshiped. Then he
came to his own house; and when he
requested, they set bread before him and
he ate.
21 Then his servants said to him, "What
is this that you have done? You fasted and
wept for the child while he was alive, but
when the child was dead, you rose up and
ate bread."
22 He said, "While the child was yet
alive, I fasted and wept; for I said, 'Who
knows whether Yahweh will not be
gracious to me, that the child may live?'
23 But now he is dead. Why should I
fast? Can I bring him back again? I will go
to him, but he will not return to me."
24 David comforted Bathsheba his wife,
and went in to her, and lay with her. She
bore a son, and he called his name
Solomon. Yahweh loved him;
25 and he sent by the hand of Nathan the
prophet, and he named him Jedidiah,† for
Yahweh's sake.
26 Now Joab fought against Rabbah of
the children of Ammon, and took the
royal city.

† **12:25** "Jedidiah" means "loved by Yahweh".

27 Joab sent messengers to David, and
said, “I have fought against Rabbah. Yes, I
have taken the city of waters.
28 Now therefore gather the rest of the
people together, and encamp against the
city and take it; lest I take the city, and it
be called by my name.”
29 David gathered all the people
together and went to Rabbah, and fought
against it and took it.
30 He took the crown of their king from
off his head; and its weight was a talent‡ of
gold, and in it were precious stones; and it
was set on David’s head. He brought a
great quantity of plunder out of the city.
31 He brought out the people who were
in it, and put them to work under saws,
under iron picks, under axes of iron, and
made them go to the brick kiln; and he did
so to all the cities of the children of
Ammon. Then David and all the people
returned to Jerusalem.

13

1 After this, Absalom the son of David
had a beautiful sister, whose name was
Tamar; and Amnon the son of David loved
her.
2 Amnon was so troubled that he
became sick because of his sister Tamar,
for she was a virgin, and it seemed hard to
Amnon to do anything to her.
3 But Amnon had a friend whose name
was Jonadab the son of Shimeah, David’s
brother; and Jonadab was a very subtle
man.
4 He said to him, “Why, son of the king,
are you so sad from day to day? Won’t you
tell me?”
Amnon said to him, “I love Tamar, my
brother Absalom’s sister.”
5 Jonadab said to him, “Lay down on
your bed and pretend to be sick. When
your father comes to see you, tell him,
‘Please let my sister Tamar come and give
me bread to eat, and prepare the food in
my sight, that I may see it and eat it from
her hand.’ ”
6 So Amnon lay down and faked being
sick. When the king came to see him,
Amnon said to the king, “Please let my
sister Tamar come and make me a couple
of cakes in my sight, that I may eat from
her hand.”
7 Then David sent home to Tamar,
saying, “Go now to your brother Amnon’s
house, and prepare food for him.”
8 So Tamar went to her brother
Amnon’s house; and he was lying down.
She took dough, kneaded it, made cakes in
his sight, and baked the cakes.
9 She took the pan and poured them out
before him, but he refused to eat. Amnon
said, “Have all men leave me.” Then every
man went out from him.
10 Amnon said to Tamar, “Bring the food
into the room, that I may eat from your
hand.” Tamar took the cakes which she
had made, and brought them into the
room to Amnon her brother.
11 When she had brought them near to
him to eat, he took hold of her and said to
her, “Come, lie with me, my sister!”
12 She answered him, “No, my brother,
do not force me! For no such thing ought
to be done in Israel. Don’t you do this
folly!
13 As for me, where would I carry my
shame? And as for you, you will be as one
of the fools in Israel. Now therefore,
please speak to the king; for he will not
withhold me from you.”
14 However, he would not listen to her
voice; but being stronger than she, he
forced her and lay with her.
15 Then Amnon hated her with
exceedingly great hatred; for the hatred
with which he hated her was greater than
the love with which he had loved her.
Amnon said to her, “Arise, be gone!”
16 She said to him, “Not so, because this
great wrong in sending me away is worse
than the other that you did to me!”
But he would not listen to her.
17 Then he called his servant who
ministered to him, and said, “Now put this
woman out from me, and bolt the door
after her.”
18 She had a garment of various colors
on her, for the king’s daughters who were
virgins dressed in such robes. Then his

‡ **12:30** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

servant brought her out and bolted the door after her.
19 Tamar put ashes on her head, and tore her garment of various colors that was on her; and she laid her hand on her head and went her way, crying aloud as she went.
20 Absalom her brother said to her, “Has Amnon your brother been with you? But now hold your peace, my sister. He is your brother. Don’t take this thing to heart.”

So Tamar remained desolate in her brother Absalom’s house.
21 But when King David heard of all these things, he was very angry.
22 Absalom spoke to Amnon neither good nor bad; for Absalom hated Amnon, because he had forced his sister Tamar.
23 After two full years, Absalom had sheep shearers in Baal Hazor, which is beside Ephraim; and Absalom invited all the king’s sons.
24 Absalom came to the king and said, “See now, your servant has sheep shearers. Please let the king and his servants go with your servant.”
25 The king said to Absalom, “No, my son, let’s not all go, lest we be burdensome to you.” He pressed him; however he would not go, but blessed him.
26 Then Absalom said, “If not, please let my brother Amnon go with us.”

The king said to him, “Why should he go with you?”
27 But Absalom pressed him, and he let Amnon and all the king’s sons go with him.
28 Absalom commanded his servants, saying, “Mark now, when Amnon’s heart is merry with wine; and when I tell you, ‘Strike Amnon,’ then kill him. Don’t be afraid. Haven’t I commanded you? Be courageous, and be valiant!”
29 The servants of Absalom did to Amnon as Absalom had commanded. Then all the king’s sons arose, and every man got up on his mule and fled.
30 While they were on the way, the news came to David, saying, “Absalom has slain all the king’s sons, and there is not one of them left!”
31 Then the king arose, and tore his garments, and lay on the earth; and all his servants stood by with their clothes torn.
32 Jonadab the son of Shimeah, David’s brother, answered, “Don’t let my lord suppose that they have killed all the young men, the king’s sons, for Amnon only is dead; for by the appointment of Absalom this has been determined from the day that he forced his sister Tamar.
33 Now therefore don’t let my lord the king take the thing to his heart, to think that all the king’s sons are dead; for only Amnon is dead.”
34 But Absalom fled. The young man who kept the watch lifted up his eyes and looked, and behold, many people were coming by way of the hillside behind him.
35 Jonadab said to the king, “Behold, the king’s sons are coming! It is as your servant said.”
36 As soon as he had finished speaking, behold, the king’s sons came, and lifted up their voices and wept. The king also and all his servants wept bitterly.

37 But Absalom fled and went to Talmai the son of Ammihur, king of Geshur. David mourned for his son every day.
38 So Absalom fled and went to Geshur, and was there three years.
39 King David longed to go out to Absalom, for he was comforted concerning Amnon, since he was dead.

14

1 Now Joab the son of Zeruiah perceived that the king’s heart was toward Absalom.
2 Joab sent to Tekoa and brought a wise woman from there, and said to her, “Please act like a mourner, and put on mourning clothing, please, and don’t anoint yourself with oil; but be as a woman who has mourned a long time for the dead.
3 Go in to the king and speak like this to him.” So Joab put the words in her mouth.
4 When the woman of Tekoa spoke to the king, she fell on her face to the ground, showed respect, and said, “Help, O king!”
5 The king said to her, “What ails you?”

She answered, “Truly I am a widow,
and my husband is dead.
6 Your servant had two sons; and they
both fought together in the field, and
there was no one to part them, but the one
struck the other and killed him.
7 Behold, the whole family has risen
against your servant, and they say,
‘Deliver him who struck his brother, that
we may kill him for the life of his brother
whom he killed, and so destroy the heir
also.’ Thus they would quench my coal
which is left, and would leave to my
husband neither name nor remainder on
the surface of the earth.”
8 The king said to the woman, “Go to
your house, and I will give a command
concerning you.”
9 The woman of Tekoa said to the king,
“My lord, O king, may the iniquity be on
me, and on my father’s house; and may
the king and his throne be guiltless.”
10 The king said, “Whoever says
anything to you, bring him to me, and he
will not bother you any more.”
11 Then she said, “Please let the king
remember Yahweh your God, that the
avenger of blood destroy not any more,
lest they destroy my son.”
He said, “As Yahweh lives, not one hair
of your son shall fall to the earth.”
12 Then the woman said, “Please let your
servant speak a word to my lord the king.”
He said, “Say on.”
13 The woman said, “Why then have you
devised such a thing against the people of
God? For in speaking this word the king is
as one who is guilty, in that the king does
not bring home again his banished one.
14 For we must die, and are like water
spilled on the ground, which can’t be
gathered up again; neither does God take
away life, but devises means, that he who
is banished not be an outcast from him.
15 Now therefore, seeing that I have
come to speak this word to my lord the
king, it is because the people have made
me afraid. Your servant said, ‘I will now
speak to the king; it may be that the king
will perform the request of his servant.’
16 For the king will hear, to deliver his
servant out of the hand of the man who
would destroy me and my son together
out of the inheritance of God.
17 Then your servant said, ‘Please let the
word of my lord the king bring rest; for as
an angel of God, so is my lord the king to
discern good and bad. May Yahweh, your
God, be with you.’ ”
18 Then the king answered the woman,
“Please don’t hide anything from me that I
ask you.”
The woman said, “Let my lord the king
now speak.”
19 The king said, “Is the hand of Joab
with you in all this?”
The woman answered, “As your soul
lives, my lord the king, no one can turn to
the right hand or to the left from anything
that my lord the king has spoken; for your
servant Joab urged me, and he put all
these words in the mouth of your servant.
20 Your servant Joab has done this thing
to change the face of the matter. My lord
is wise, according to the wisdom of an
angel of God, to know all things that are in
the earth.”
21 The king said to Joab, “Behold now, I
have granted this thing. Go therefore, and
bring the young man Absalom back.”
22 Joab fell to the ground on his face,
showed respect, and blessed the king.
Joab said, “Today your servant knows that
I have found favor in your sight, my lord,
O king, in that the king has performed the
request of his servant.”
23 So Joab arose and went to Geshur,
and brought Absalom to Jerusalem.
24 The king said, “Let him return to his
own house, but let him not see my face.”
So Absalom returned to his own house,
and didn’t see the king’s face.
25 Now in all Israel there was no one to
be so much praised as Absalom for his
beauty. From the sole of his foot even to
the crown of his head there was no defect
in him.
26 When he cut the hair of his head (now
it was at every year’s end that he cut it;
because it was heavy on him, therefore he
cut it), he weighed the hair of his head at

two hundred shekels,† after the king's
weight.
27 Three sons were born to Absalom,
and one daughter, whose name was
Tamar. She was a woman with a beautiful
face.
28 Absalom lived two full years in
Jerusalem, and he didn't see the king's
face.
29 Then Absalom sent for Joab, to send
him to the king, but he would not come to
him. Then he sent again a second time,
but he would not come.
30 Therefore he said to his servants,
"Behold, Joab's field is near mine, and he
has barley there. Go and set it on fire." So
Absalom's servants set the field on fire.
31 Then Joab arose and came to Absalom
to his house, and said to him, "Why have
your servants set my field on fire?"
32 Absalom answered Joab, "Behold, I
sent to you, saying, 'Come here, that I may
send you to the king, to say, "Why have I
come from Geshur? It would be better for
me to be there still. Now therefore, let me
see the king's face; and if there is iniquity
in me, let him kill me." ' "
33 So Joab came to the king and told him;
and when he had called for Absalom, he
came to the king and bowed himself on
his face to the ground before the king; and
the king kissed Absalom.

15

1 After this, Absalom prepared a chariot
and horses for himself, and fifty men to
run before him.
2 Absalom rose up early, and stood
beside the way of the gate. When any man
had a suit which should come to the king
for judgment, then Absalom called to him,
and said, "What city are you from?"
He said, "Your servant is of one of the
tribes of Israel."
3 Absalom said to him, "Behold, your
matters are good and right; but there is no
man deputized by the king to hear you."
4 Absalom said moreover, "Oh that I
were made judge in the land, that every
man who has any suit or cause might
come to me, and I would do him justice!"
5 It was so, that when any man came
near to bow down to him, he stretched out
his hand, took hold of him, and kissed
him.
6 Absalom did this sort of thing to all
Israel who came to the king for judgment.
So Absalom stole the hearts of the men of
Israel.
7 At the end of forty years, Absalom said
to the king, "Please let me go and pay my
vow, which I have vowed to Yahweh, in
Hebron.
8 For your servant vowed a vow while I
stayed at Geshur in Syria, saying, 'If
Yahweh shall indeed bring me again to
Jerusalem, then I will serve Yahweh.' "
9 The king said to him, "Go in peace."
So he arose and went to Hebron.
10 But Absalom sent spies throughout all
the tribes of Israel, saying, "As soon as you
hear the sound of the trumpet, then you
shall say, 'Absalom is king in Hebron!' "
11 Two hundred men went with
Absalom out of Jerusalem, who were
invited, and went in their simplicity; and
they didn't know anything.
12 Absalom sent for Ahithophel the
Gilonite, David's counselor, from his city,
even from Giloh, while he was offering
the sacrifices. The conspiracy was strong,
for the people increased continually with
Absalom.
13 A messenger came to David, saying,
"The hearts of the men of Israel are after
Absalom."
14 David said to all his servants who
were with him at Jerusalem, "Arise! Let's
flee, or else none of us will escape from
Absalom. Hurry to depart, lest he
overtake us quickly and bring down evil
on us, and strike the city with the edge of
the sword."
15 The king's servants said to the king,
"Behold, your servants are ready to do
whatever my lord the king chooses."
16 The king went out, and all his
household after him. The king left ten
women, who were concubines, to keep
the house.

† **14:26** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 200 shekels is about 2 kilograms or about 4.4 pounds.

17 The king went out, and all the people
after him; and they stayed in Beth
Merhak.
18 All his servants passed on beside him;
and all the Cherethites, and all the
Pelethites, and all the Gittites, six hundred
men who came after him from Gath,
passed on before the king.
19 Then the king said to Ittai the Gittite,
"Why do you also go with us? Return, and
stay with the king; for you are a foreigner
and also an exile. Return to your own
place.
20 Whereas you came but yesterday,
should I today make you go up and down
with us, since I go where I may? Return,
and take back your brothers. Mercy and
truth be with you."
21 Ittai answered the king and said, "As
Yahweh lives, and as my lord the king
lives, surely in what place my lord the
king is, whether for death or for life, your
servant will be there also."
22 David said to Ittai, "Go and pass over."
Ittai the Gittite passed over, and all his
men, and all the little ones who were with
him.
23 All the country wept with a loud
voice, and all the people passed over. The
king also himself passed over the brook
Kidron, and all the people passed over
toward the way of the wilderness.
24 Behold, Zadok also came, and all the
Levites with him, bearing the ark of the
covenant of God; and they set down God's
ark; and Abiathar went up until all the
people finished passing out of the city.
25 The king said to Zadok, "Carry God's
ark back into the city. If I find favor in
Yahweh's eyes, he will bring me again,
and show me both it and his habitation;
26 but if he says, 'I have no delight in
you,' behold, here I am. Let him do to me
as seems good to him."
27 The king said also to Zadok the priest,
"Aren't you a seer? Return into the city in
peace, and your two sons with you,
Ahimaaz your son and Jonathan the son
of Abiathar.
28 Behold, I will stay at the fords of the
wilderness until word comes from you to
inform me."
29 Zadok therefore and Abiathar carried
God's ark to Jerusalem again; and they
stayed there.
30 David went up by the ascent of the
Mount of Olives, and wept as he went up;
and he had his head covered and went
barefoot. All the people who were with
him each covered his head, and they went
up, weeping as they went up.
31 Someone told David, saying,
"Ahithophel is among the conspirators
with Absalom."
David said, "Yahweh, please turn the
counsel of Ahithophel into foolishness."
32 When David had come to the top,
where God was worshiped, behold,
Hushai the Archite came to meet him with
his tunic torn and earth on his head.
33 David said to him, "If you pass on
with me, then you will be a burden to me;
34 but if you return to the city, and tell
Absalom, 'I will be your servant, O king.
As I have been your father's servant in
time past, so I will now be your servant;
then you will defeat for me the counsel of
Ahithophel.'
35 Don't you have Zadok and Abiathar
the priests there with you? Therefore
whatever you hear out of the king's house,
tell it to Zadok and Abiathar the priests.
36 Behold, they have there with them
their two sons, Ahimaaz, Zadok's son, and
Jonathan, Abiathar's son. Send to me
everything that you shall hear by them."
37 So Hushai, David's friend, came into
the city; and Absalom came into
Jerusalem.

16

1 When David was a little past the top,
behold, Ziba the servant of Mephibosheth
met him with a couple of donkeys
saddled, and on them two hundred loaves
of bread, and one hundred clusters of
raisins, and one hundred summer fruits,
and a container of wine.
2 The king said to Ziba, "What do you
mean by these?"
Ziba said, "The donkeys are for the
king's household to ride on; and the bread
and summer fruit for the young men to

eat; and the wine, that those who are faint in the wilderness may drink."
3 The king said, "Where is your master's son?"
Ziba said to the king, "Behold, he is staying in Jerusalem; for he said, 'Today the house of Israel will restore me the kingdom of my father.' "
4 Then the king said to Ziba, "Behold, all that belongs to Mephibosheth is yours."
Ziba said, "I bow down. Let me find favor in your sight, my lord, O king."
5 When King David came to Bahurim, behold, a man of the family of Saul's house came out, whose name was Shimei, the son of Gera. He came out and cursed as he came.
6 He cast stones at David and at all the servants of King David, and all the people and all the mighty men were on his right hand and on his left.
7 Shimei said when he cursed, "Be gone, be gone, you man of blood, and wicked fellow!
8 Yahweh has returned on you all the blood of Saul's house, in whose place you have reigned! Yahweh has delivered the kingdom into the hand of Absalom your son! Behold, you are caught by your own mischief, because you are a man of blood!"
9 Then Abishai the son of Zeruiah said to the king, "Why should this dead dog curse my lord the king? Please let me go over and take off his head."
10 The king said, "What have I to do with you, you sons of Zeruiah? Because he curses, and because Yahweh has said to him, 'Curse David,' who then shall say, 'Why have you done so?' "
11 David said to Abishai and to all his servants, "Behold, my son, who came out of my bowels, seeks my life. How much more this Benjamite, now? Leave him alone, and let him curse; for Yahweh has invited him.
12 It may be that Yahweh will look on the wrong done to me, and that Yahweh will repay me good for the cursing of me today."
13 So David and his men went by the way; and Shimei went along on the hillside opposite him and cursed as he went, threw stones at him, and threw dust.
14 The king and all the people who were with him arrived weary; and he refreshed himself there.
15 Absalom and all the people, the men of Israel, came to Jerusalem, and Ahithophel with him.
16 When Hushai the Archite, David's friend, had come to Absalom, Hushai said to Absalom, "Long live the king! Long live the king!"
17 Absalom said to Hushai, "Is this your kindness to your friend? Why didn't you go with your friend?"
18 Hushai said to Absalom, "No; but whomever Yahweh and this people and all the men of Israel have chosen, I will be his, and I will stay with him.
19 Again, whom should I serve? Shouldn't I serve in the presence of his son? As I have served in your father's presence, so I will be in your presence."
20 Then Absalom said to Ahithophel, "Give your counsel what we shall do."
21 Ahithophel said to Absalom, "Go in to your father's concubines that he has left to keep the house. Then all Israel will hear that you are abhorred by your father. Then the hands of all who are with you will be strong."
22 So they spread a tent for Absalom on the top of the house, and Absalom went in to his father's concubines in the sight of all Israel.
23 The counsel of Ahithophel, which he gave in those days, was as if a man inquired at the inner sanctuary of God. All the counsel of Ahithophel was like this both with David and with Absalom.

17

1 Moreover Ahithophel said to Absalom, "Let me now choose twelve thousand men, and I will arise and pursue after David tonight.
2 I will come on him while he is weary and exhausted, and will make him afraid. All the people who are with him will flee. I will strike the king only,

3 and I will bring back all the people to
you. The man whom you seek is as if all
returned. All the people shall be in peace."
4 The saying pleased Absalom well, and
all the elders of Israel.
5 Then Absalom said, "Now call Hushai
the Archite also, and let's hear likewise
what he says."
6 When Hushai had come to Absalom,
Absalom spoke to him, saying,
"Ahithophel has spoken like this. Shall we
do what he says? If not, speak up."
7 Hushai said to Absalom, "The counsel
that Ahithophel has given this time is not
good."
8 Hushai said moreover, "You know
your father and his men, that they are
mighty men, and they are fierce in their
minds, like a bear robbed of her cubs in
the field. Your father is a man of war, and
will not lodge with the people.
9 Behold, he is now hidden in some pit,
or in some other place. It will happen,
when some of them have fallen at the
first, that whoever hears it will say, 'There
is a slaughter among the people who
follow Absalom!'
10 Even he who is valiant, whose heart is
as the heart of a lion, will utterly melt; for
all Israel knows that your father is a
mighty man, and those who are with him
are valiant men.
11 But I counsel that all Israel be
gathered together to you, from Dan even
to Beersheba, as the sand that is by the sea
for multitude; and that you go to battle in
your own person.
12 So we will come on him in some place
where he will be found, and we will light
on him as the dew falls on the ground,
then we will not leave so much as one of
him and of all the men who are with him.
13 Moreover, if he has gone into a city,
then all Israel will bring ropes to that city,
and we will draw it into the river, until
there isn't one small stone found there."
14 Absalom and all the men of Israel
said, "The counsel of Hushai the Archite is
better than the counsel of Ahithophel."
For Yahweh had ordained to defeat the
good counsel of Ahithophel, to the intent
that Yahweh might bring evil on Absalom.
15 Then Hushai said to Zadok and to
Abiathar the priests, "Ahithophel
counseled Absalom and the elders of
Israel that way; and I have counseled this
way.
16 Now therefore send quickly, and tell
David, saying, 'Don't lodge tonight at the
fords of the wilderness, but by all means
pass over, lest the king be swallowed up,
and all the people who are with him.' "
17 Now Jonathan and Ahimaaz were
staying by En Rogel; and a female servant
used to go and report to them, and they
went and told King David; for they
couldn't risk being seen coming into the
city.
18 But a boy saw them, and told
Absalom. Then they both went away
quickly and came to the house of a man in
Bahurim, who had a well in his court; and
they went down there.
19 The woman took and spread the
covering over the well's mouth, and
spread out crushed grain on it; and
nothing was known.
20 Absalom's servants came to the
woman to the house; and they said,
"Where are Ahimaaz and Jonathan?"
The woman said to them, "They have
gone over the brook of water."
When they had sought and could not
find them, they returned to Jerusalem.
21 After they had departed, they came
up out of the well and went and told King
David; and they said to David, "Arise and
pass quickly over the water; for thus has
Ahithophel counseled against you."
22 Then David arose, and all the people
who were with him, and they passed over
the Jordan. By the morning light there
lacked not one of them who had not gone
over the Jordan.
23 When Ahithophel saw that his
counsel was not followed, he saddled his
donkey, arose, and went home to his city,
set his house in order, and hanged
himself; and he died, and was buried in
the tomb of his father.
24 Then David came to Mahanaim.
Absalom passed over the Jordan, he and
all the men of Israel with him.

25 Absalom set Amasa over the army
instead of Joab. Now Amasa was the son
of a man whose name was Ithra the
Israelite, who went in to Abigail the
daughter of Nahash, sister to Zeruiah,
Joab's mother.
26 Israel and Absalom encamped in the
land of Gilead.
27 When David had come to Mahanaim,
Shobi the son of Nahash of Rabbah of the
children of Ammon, and Machir the son
of Ammiel of Lodebar, and Barzillai the
Gileadite of Rogelim,
28 brought beds, basins, earthen vessels,
wheat, barley, meal, parched grain,
beans, lentils, roasted grain,
29 honey, butter, sheep, and cheese of
the herd, for David and for the people
who were with him to eat; for they said,
"The people are hungry, weary, and
thirsty in the wilderness."

18

1 David counted the people who were
with him, and set captains of thousands
and captains of hundreds over them.
2 David sent the people out, a third part
under the hand of Joab, and a third part
under the hand of Abishai the son of
Zeruiah, Joab's brother, and a third part
under the hand of Ittai the Gittite. The
king said to the people, "I will also surely
go out with you myself."
3 But the people said, "You shall not go
out, for if we flee away, they will not care
for us, neither if half of us die, will they
care for us. But you are worth ten
thousand of us. Therefore now it is better
that you are ready to help us out of the
city."
4 The king said to them, "I will do what
seems best to you."
The king stood beside the gate, and all
the people went out by hundreds and by
thousands.
5 The king commanded Joab and
Abishai and Ittai, saying, "Deal gently for
my sake with the young man Absalom."
All the people heard when the king
commanded all the captains concerning
Absalom.
6 So the people went out into the field
against Israel; and the battle was in the
forest of Ephraim.
7 The people of Israel were struck there
before David's servants, and there was a
great slaughter there that day of twenty
thousand men.
8 For the battle was there spread over
the surface of all the country, and the
forest devoured more people that day
than the sword devoured.
9 Absalom happened to meet David's
servants. Absalom was riding on his
mule, and the mule went under the thick
boughs of a great oak; and his head
caught hold of the oak, and he was
hanging between the sky and earth; and
the mule that was under him went on.
10 A certain man saw it, and told Joab,
and said, "Behold, I saw Absalom hanging
in an oak."
11 Joab said to the man who told him,
"Behold, you saw it, and why didn't you
strike him there to the ground? I would
have given you ten pieces of silver and a
sash."
12 The man said to Joab, "Though I
should receive a thousand pieces of silver
in my hand, I still wouldn't stretch out my
hand against the king's son; for in our
hearing the king commanded you and
Abishai and Ittai, saying, 'Beware that no
one touch the young man Absalom.'
13 Otherwise, if I had dealt falsely
against his life (and there is no matter
hidden from the king), then you yourself
would have set yourself against me."
14 Then Joab said, "I'm not going to wait
like this with you." He took three darts in
his hand and thrust them through
Absalom's heart while he was still alive in
the middle of the oak.
15 Ten young men who bore Joab's
armor surrounded and struck Absalom,
and killed him.
16 Joab blew the trumpet, and the
people returned from pursuing after
Israel; for Joab held the people back.
17 They took Absalom and cast him into
a great pit in the forest, and raised over
him a very great heap of stones. Then all
Israel fled, each to his own tent.

18 Now Absalom in his lifetime had
taken and reared up for himself the pillar
which is in the king's valley, for he said, "I
have no son to keep my name in memory."
He called the pillar after his own name. It
is called Absalom's monument, to this day.
19 Then Ahimaaz the son of Zadok said,
"Let me now run and carry the king news,
how Yahweh has avenged him of his
enemies."
20 Joab said to him, "You must not be the
bearer of news today, but you must carry
news another day. But today you must
carry no news, because the king's son is
dead."
21 Then Joab said to the Cushite, "Go, tell
the king what you have seen!" The
Cushite bowed himself to Joab, and ran.
22 Then Ahimaaz the son of Zadok said
yet again to Joab, "But come what may,
please let me also run after the Cushite."
Joab said, "Why do you want to run, my
son, since you will have no reward for the
news?"
23 "But come what may," he said, "I will
run."
He said to him, "Run!" Then Ahimaaz
ran by the way of the Plain, and outran
the Cushite.
24 Now David was sitting between the
two gates; and the watchman went up to
the roof of the gate to the wall, and lifted
up his eyes and looked, and, behold, a
man running alone.
25 The watchman shouted and told the
king. The king said, "If he is alone, there is
news in his mouth." He came closer and
closer.
26 The watchman saw another man
running; and the watchman called to the
gatekeeper and said, "Behold, a man
running alone!"
The king said, "He also brings news."
27 The watchman said, "I think the
running of the first one is like the running
of Ahimaaz the son of Zadok."
The king said, "He is a good man, and
comes with good news."
28 Ahimaaz called, and said to the king,
"All is well." He bowed himself before the
king with his face to the earth, and said,
"Blessed is Yahweh your God, who has
delivered up the men who lifted up their
hand against my lord the king!"
29 The king said, "Is it well with the
young man Absalom?"
Ahimaaz answered, "When Joab sent
the king's servant, even me your servant, I
saw a great tumult, but I don't know what
it was."
30 The king said, "Come and stand here."
He came and stood still.
31 Behold, the Cushite came. The Cushite
said, "Good news for my lord the king, for
Yahweh has avenged you today of all
those who rose up against you."
32 The king said to the Cushite, "Is it well
with the young man Absalom?"
The Cushite answered, "May the
enemies of my lord the king, and all who
rise up against you to do you harm, be as
that young man is."
33 The king was much moved, and went
up to the room over the gate and wept. As
he went, he said, "My son Absalom! My
son, my son Absalom! I wish I had died
instead of you, Absalom, my son, my son!"

19

1 Joab was told, "Behold, the king weeps
and mourns for Absalom."
2 The victory that day was turned into
mourning among all the people, for the
people heard it said that day, "The king
grieves for his son."
3 The people sneaked into the city that
day, as people who are ashamed steal
away when they flee in battle.
4 The king covered his face, and the king
cried with a loud voice, "My son Absalom,
Absalom, my son, my son!"
5 Joab came into the house to the king,
and said, "Today you have shamed the
faces of all your servants who today have
saved your life, and the lives of your sons
and of your daughters, and the lives of
your wives, and the lives of your
concubines;
6 in that you love those who hate you
and hate those who love you. For you
have declared today that princes and
servants are nothing to you. For today I
perceive that if Absalom had lived and we

had all died today, then it would have pleased you well.
7 Now therefore arise, go out and speak to comfort your servants; for I swear by Yahweh, if you don't go out, not a man will stay with you this night. That would be worse to you than all the evil that has happened to you from your youth until now."
8 Then the king arose and sat in the gate. The people were all told, "Behold, the king is sitting in the gate." All the people came before the king. Now Israel had fled every man to his tent.
9 All the people were at strife throughout all the tribes of Israel, saying, "The king delivered us out of the hand of our enemies, and he saved us out of the hand of the Philistines; and now he has fled out of the land from Absalom.
10 Absalom, whom we anointed over us, is dead in battle. Now therefore why don't you speak a word of bringing the king back?"
11 King David sent to Zadok and to Abiathar the priests, saying, "Speak to the elders of Judah, saying, 'Why are you the last to bring the king back to his house, since the speech of all Israel has come to the king, to return him to his house?
12 You are my brothers. You are my bone and my flesh. Why then are you the last to bring back the king?'
13 Say to Amasa, 'Aren't you my bone and my flesh? God do so to me, and more also, if you aren't captain of the army before me continually instead of Joab.' "
14 He bowed the heart of all the men of Judah, even as one man, so that they sent to the king, saying, "Return, you and all your servants."
15 So the king returned, and came to the Jordan. Judah came to Gilgal, to go to meet the king, to bring the king over the Jordan.
16 Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjamite, who was of Bahurim, hurried and came down with the men of Judah to meet King David.
17 There were a thousand men of Benjamin with him, and Ziba the servant of Saul's house, and his fifteen sons and his twenty servants with him; and they went through the Jordan in the presence of the king.
18 A ferry boat went to bring over the king's household, and to do what he thought good.

Shimei the son of Gera fell down before the king when he had come over the Jordan.
19 He said to the king, "Don't let my lord impute iniquity to me, or remember that which your servant did perversely the day that my lord the king went out of Jerusalem, that the king should take it to his heart.
20 For your servant knows that I have sinned. Therefore behold, I have come today as the first of all the house of Joseph to go down to meet my lord the king."
21 But Abishai the son of Zeruiah answered, "Shouldn't Shimei be put to death for this, because he cursed Yahweh's anointed?"
22 David said, "What have I to do with you, you sons of Zeruiah, that you should be adversaries to me today? Shall any man be put to death today in Israel? For don't I know that I am king over Israel today?"
23 The king said to Shimei, "You will not die." The king swore to him.
24 Mephibosheth the son of Saul came down to meet the king; and he had neither groomed his feet, nor trimmed his beard, nor washed his clothes, from the day the king departed until the day he came home in peace.
25 When he had come to Jerusalem to meet the king, the king said to him, "Why didn't you go with me, Mephibosheth?"
26 He answered, "My lord, O king, my servant deceived me. For your servant said, 'I will saddle a donkey for myself, that I may ride on it and go with the king,' because your servant is lame.
27 He has slandered your servant to my lord the king, but my lord the king is as an angel of God. Therefore do what is good in your eyes.
28 For all my father's house were but dead men before my lord the king; yet you set your servant among those who ate at

your own table. What right therefore have I yet that I should appeal any more to the king?"

29 The king said to him, "Why do you speak any more of your matters? I say, you and Ziba divide the land."

30 Mephibosheth said to the king, "Yes, let him take all, because my lord the king has come in peace to his own house."

31 Barzillai the Gileadite came down from Rogelim; and he went over the Jordan with the king to conduct him over the Jordan.

32 Now Barzillai was a very aged man, even eighty years old. He had provided the king with sustenance while he stayed at Mahanaim, for he was a very great man.

33 The king said to Barzillai, "Come over with me, and I will sustain you with me in Jerusalem."

34 Barzillai said to the king, "How many are the days of the years of my life, that I should go up with the king to Jerusalem?

35 I am eighty years old, today. Can I discern between good and bad? Can your servant taste what I eat or what I drink? Can I hear the voice of singing men and singing women any more? Why then should your servant be a burden to my lord the king?

36 Your servant will just go over the Jordan with the king. Why should the king repay me with such a reward?

37 Please let your servant turn back again, that I may die in my own city, by the grave of my father and my mother. But behold, your servant Chimham; let him go over with my lord the king; and do to him what shall seem good to you."

38 The king answered, "Chimham shall go over with me, and I will do to him that which shall seem good to you. Whatever you request of me, that I will do for you."

39 All the people went over the Jordan, and the king went over. Then the king kissed Barzillai and blessed him; and he returned to his own place.

40 So the king went over to Gilgal, and Chimham went over with him. All the people of Judah brought the king over, and also half the people of Israel.

41 Behold, all the men of Israel came to the king, and said to the king, "Why have our brothers the men of Judah stolen you away, and brought the king and his household, over the Jordan, and all David's men with him?"

42 All the men of Judah answered the men of Israel, "Because the king is a close relative to us. Why then are you angry about this matter? Have we eaten at all at the king's cost? Or has he given us any gift?"

43 The men of Israel answered the men of Judah, and said, "We have ten parts in the king, and we have also more claim to David than you. Why then did you despise us, that our advice should not be first had in bringing back our king?" The words of the men of Judah were fiercer than the words of the men of Israel.

20

1 There happened to be there a wicked fellow, whose name was Sheba the son of Bichri, a Benjamite; and he blew the trumpet, and said, "We have no portion in David, neither have we inheritance in the son of Jesse. Every man to his tents, Israel!"

2 So all the men of Israel went up from following David, and followed Sheba the son of Bichri; but the men of Judah joined with their king, from the Jordan even to Jerusalem.

3 David came to his house at Jerusalem; and the king took the ten women his concubines, whom he had left to keep the house, and put them in custody and provided them with sustenance, but didn't go in to them. So they were shut up to the day of their death, living in widowhood.

4 Then the king said to Amasa, "Call me the men of Judah together within three days, and be here present."

5 So Amasa went to call the men of Judah together, but he stayed longer than the set time which had been appointed to him.

6 David said to Abishai, "Now Sheba the son of Bichri will do us more harm than Absalom did. Take your lord's servants

and pursue after him, lest he get himself fortified cities, and escape out of our sight."
7 Joab's men went out after him with the Cherethites, the Pelethites, and all the mighty men; and they went out of Jerusalem to pursue Sheba the son of Bichri.
8 When they were at the great stone which is in Gibeon, Amasa came to meet them. Joab was clothed in his apparel of war that he had put on, and on it was a sash with a sword fastened on his waist in its sheath; and as he went along it fell out.
9 Joab said to Amasa, "Is it well with you, my brother?" Joab took Amasa by the beard with his right hand to kiss him.
10 But Amasa took no heed to the sword that was in Joab's hand. So he struck him with it in the body and shed out his bowels to the ground, and didn't strike him again; and he died. Joab and Abishai his brother pursued Sheba the son of Bichri.
11 One of Joab's young men stood by him, and said, "He who favors Joab, and he who is for David, let him follow Joab!"
12 Amasa lay wallowing in his blood in the middle of the highway. When the man saw that all the people stood still, he carried Amasa out of the highway into the field, and cast a garment over him when he saw that everyone who came by him stood still.
13 When he was removed out of the highway, all the people went on after Joab to pursue Sheba the son of Bichri.
14 He went through all the tribes of Israel to Abel, to Beth Maacah, and all the Berites. They were gathered together, and went also after him.
15 They came and besieged him in Abel of Beth Maacah, and they cast up a mound against the city, and it stood against the rampart; and all the people who were with Joab battered the wall to throw it down.
16 Then a wise woman cried out of the city, "Hear, hear! Please say to Joab, 'Come near here, that I may speak with you.' "
17 He came near to her; and the woman said, "Are you Joab?"
He answered, "I am."
Then she said to him, "Hear the words of your servant."
He answered, "I'm listening."
18 Then she spoke, saying, "They used to say in old times, 'They shall surely ask counsel at Abel,' and so they settled a matter.
19 I am among those who are peaceable and faithful in Israel. You seek to destroy a city and a mother in Israel. Why will you swallow up Yahweh's inheritance?"
20 Joab answered, "Far be it, far be it from me, that I should swallow up or destroy.
21 The matter is not so. But a man of the hill country of Ephraim, Sheba the son of Bichri by name, has lifted up his hand against the king, even against David. Just deliver him, and I will depart from the city."
The woman said to Joab, "Behold, his head will be thrown to you over the wall."
22 Then the woman went to all the people in her wisdom. They cut off the head of Sheba the son of Bichri, and threw it out to Joab. He blew the trumpet, and they were dispersed from the city, every man to his tent. Then Joab returned to Jerusalem to the king.
23 Now Joab was over all the army of Israel, Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and over the Pelethites,
24 Adoram was over the men subject to forced labor, Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was the recorder,
25 Sheva was scribe, Zadok and Abiathar were priests,
26 and Ira the Jairite was chief minister to David.

21

1 There was a famine in the days of David for three years, year after year; and David sought the face of Yahweh. Yahweh said, "It is for Saul, and for his bloody house, because he put the Gibeonites to death."
2 The king called the Gibeonites and said to them (now the Gibeonites were not of the children of Israel, but of the remnant of the Amorites, and the children

of Israel had sworn to them; and Saul sought to kill them in his zeal for the children of Israel and Judah);
3 and David said to the Gibeonites, “What should I do for you? And with what should I make atonement, that you may bless Yahweh’s inheritance?”
4 The Gibeonites said to him, “It is no matter of silver or gold between us and Saul or his house; neither is it for us to put any man to death in Israel.”
He said, “I will do for you whatever you say.”
5 They said to the king, “The man who consumed us and who plotted against us, that we should be destroyed from remaining in any of the borders of Israel,
6 let seven men of his sons be delivered to us, and we will hang them up to Yahweh in Gibeah of Saul, the chosen of Yahweh.”
The king said, “I will give them.”
7 But the king spared Mephibosheth the son of Jonathan the son of Saul, because of Yahweh’s oath that was between them, between David and Jonathan the son of Saul.
8 But the king took the two sons of Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, whom she bore to Saul, Armoni and Mephibosheth; and the five sons of Merab the daughter of Saul, whom she bore to Adriel the son of Barzillai the Meholathite.
9 He delivered them into the hands of the Gibeonites; and they hanged them on the mountain before Yahweh, and all seven of them fell together. They were put to death in the days of harvest, in the first days, at the beginning of barley harvest.
10 Rizpah the daughter of Aiah took sackcloth and spread it for herself on the rock, from the beginning of harvest until water poured on them from the sky. She allowed neither the birds of the sky to rest on them by day, nor the animals of the field by night.
11 David was told what Rizpah the daughter of Aiah, the concubine of Saul, had done.
12 So David went and took the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son from the men of Jabesh Gilead, who had stolen them from the street of Beth Shan, where the Philistines had hanged them in the day that the Philistines killed Saul in Gilboa;
13 and he brought up from there the bones of Saul and the bones of Jonathan his son. They also gathered the bones of those who were hanged.
14 They buried the bones of Saul and Jonathan his son in the country of Benjamin in Zela, in the tomb of Kish his father; and they performed all that the king commanded. After that, God answered prayer for the land.
15 The Philistines had war again with Israel; and David went down, and his servants with him, and fought against the Philistines. David grew faint;
16 and Ishbibenob, who was of the sons of the giant, the weight of whose spear was three hundred shekels of bronze in weight, he being armed with a new sword, thought he would kill David.
17 But Abishai the son of Zeruiah helped him, and struck the Philistine and killed him. Then the men of David swore to him, saying, “Don’t go out with us to battle any more, so that you don’t quench the lamp of Israel.”
18 After this, there was again war with the Philistines at Gob. Then Sibbecai the Hushathite killed Saph, who was of the sons of the giant.
19 There was again war with the Philistines at Gob, and Elhanan the son of Jaare-Oregim the Bethlehemite killed Goliath the Gittite’s brother, the staff of whose spear was like a weaver’s beam.
20 There was again war at Gath, where there was a man of great stature, who had six fingers on every hand and six toes on every foot, twenty-four in number, and he also was born to the giant.
21 When he defied Israel, Jonathan the son of Shimei, David’s brother, killed him.
22 These four were born to the giant in Gath; and they fell by the hand of David and by the hand of his servants.

22

1 David spoke to Yahweh the words of this song in the day that Yahweh delivered

him out of the hand of all his enemies, and
out of the hand of Saul,
2 and he said:
"Yahweh is my rock,
my fortress,
and my deliverer, even mine;
3 God is my rock in whom I take refuge;
my shield, and the horn of my
salvation,
my high tower, and my refuge.
My savior, you save me from
violence.
4 I call on Yahweh, who is worthy to be
praised;
So shall I be saved from my enemies.

5 For the waves of death surrounded me.
The floods of ungodliness made me
afraid.
6 The cords of Sheol† were around me.
The snares of death caught me.
7 In my distress, I called on Yahweh.
Yes, I called to my God.
He heard my voice out of his temple.
My cry came into his ears.
8 Then the earth shook and trembled.
The foundations of heaven quaked
and were shaken,
because he was angry.
9 Smoke went up out of his nostrils.
Consuming fire came out of his
mouth.
Coals were kindled by it.
10 He bowed the heavens also, and came
down.
Thick darkness was under his feet.
11 He rode on a cherub, and flew.
Yes, he was seen on the wings of the
wind.
12 He made darkness a shelter around
himself,
gathering of waters, and thick clouds
of the skies.
13 At the brightness before him,
coals of fire were kindled.
14 Yahweh thundered from heaven.
The Most High uttered his voice.
15 He sent out arrows and scattered them,
lightning and confused them.
16 Then the channels of the sea appeared.
The foundations of the world were
laid bare by Yahweh's rebuke,
at the blast of the breath of his
nostrils.

17 He sent from on high and he took me.
He drew me out of many waters.
18 He delivered me from my strong enemy,
from those who hated me, for they
were too mighty for me.
19 They came on me in the day of my
calamity,
but Yahweh was my support.
20 He also brought me out into a large
place.
He delivered me, because he
delighted in me.

21 Yahweh rewarded me according to my
righteousness.
He rewarded me according to the
cleanness of my hands.
22 For I have kept Yahweh's ways,
and have not wickedly departed from
my God.
23 For all his ordinances were before me.
As for his statutes, I didn't depart
from them.
24 I was also perfect toward him.
I kept myself from my iniquity.
25 Therefore Yahweh has rewarded me
according to my righteousness,
According to my cleanness in his
eyesight.

26 With the merciful you will show
yourself merciful.
With the perfect man you will show
yourself perfect.
27 With the pure you will show
yourself pure.
With the crooked you will show
yourself shrewd.
28 You will save the afflicted people,
but your eyes are on the arrogant,
that you may bring them down.
29 For you are my lamp, Yahweh.
Yahweh will light up my darkness.
30 For by you, I run against a troop.
By my God, I leap over a wall.
31 As for God, his way is perfect.
Yahweh's word is tested.

† **22:6** Sheol is the place of the dead.

He is a shield to all those who take
refuge in him.

32 For who is God, besides Yahweh?
Who is a rock, besides our God?
33 God is my strong fortress.
He makes my way perfect.
34 He makes his feet like hinds' feet,
and sets me on my high places.
35 He teaches my hands to war,
so that my arms bend a bow of
bronze.
36 You have also given me the shield of
your salvation.
Your gentleness has made me great.
37 You have enlarged my steps under me.
My feet have not slipped.
38 I have pursued my enemies and
destroyed them.
I didn't turn again until they were
consumed.
39 I have consumed them,
and struck them through,
so that they can't arise.
Yes, they have fallen under my feet.
40 For you have armed me with strength
for the battle.
You have subdued under me those
who rose up against me.
41 You have also made my enemies turn
their backs to me,
that I might cut off those who hate me.
42 They looked, but there was no one to
save;
even to Yahweh, but he didn't answer
them.
43 Then I beat them as small as the dust of
the earth.
I crushed them as the mire of the
streets, and spread them abroad.

44 You also have delivered me from the
strivings of my people.
You have kept me to be the head of
the nations.
A people whom I have not known will
serve me.
45 The foreigners will submit themselves
to me.
As soon as they hear of me, they will
obey me.
46 The foreigners will fade away,
and will come trembling out of their
close places.

47 Yahweh lives!
Blessed be my rock!
Exalted be God, the rock of my salvation,
48 even the God who executes
vengeance for me,
who brings down peoples under me,
49 who brings me away from my
enemies.
Yes, you lift me up above those who rise
up against me.
You deliver me from the violent man.
50 Therefore I will give thanks to you,
Yahweh, among the nations,
and will sing praises to your name.
51 He gives great deliverance to his king,
and shows loving kindness to his
anointed,
to David and to his offspring, forever
more."

23

1 Now these are the last words of David.
David the son of Jesse says,
the man who was raised on high says,
the anointed of the God of Jacob,
the sweet psalmist of Israel:
2 "Yahweh's Spirit spoke by me.
His word was on my tongue.
3 The God of Israel said,
the Rock of Israel spoke to me,
'One who rules over men righteously,
who rules in the fear of God,
4 shall be as the light of the morning when
the sun rises,
a morning without clouds,
when the tender grass springs out of
the earth,
through clear shining after rain.'

5 Isn't my house so with God?
Yet he has made with me an
everlasting covenant,
ordered in all things, and sure,
for it is all my salvation and all my
desire.
Won't he make it grow?
6 But all the ungodly will be as thorns to be
thrust away,
because they can't be taken with the
hand.
7 The man who touches them must be
armed with iron and the staff of a
spear.

They will be utterly burned with fire in
their place."
8 These are the names of the mighty
men whom David had: Josheb Basshebeth
a Tahchemonite, chief of the captains; he
was called Adino the Eznite, who killed
eight hundred at one time.
9 After him was Eleazar the son of Dodai
the son of an Ahohite, one of the three
mighty men with David when they defied
the Philistines who were there gathered
together to battle, and the men of Israel
had gone away.
10 He arose and struck the Philistines
until his hand was weary, and his hand
froze to the sword; and Yahweh worked a
great victory that day; and the people
returned after him only to take plunder.
11 After him was Shammah the son of
Agee a Hararite. The Philistines had
gathered together into a troop where
there was a plot of ground full of lentils;
and the people fled from the Philistines.
12 But he stood in the middle of the plot
and defended it, and killed the Philistines;
and Yahweh worked a great victory.
13 Three of the thirty chief men went
down, and came to David in the harvest
time to the cave of Adullam; and the troop
of the Philistines was encamped in the
valley of Rephaim.
14 David was then in the stronghold; and
the garrison of the Philistines was then in
Bethlehem.
15 David said longingly, "Oh that
someone would give me water to drink
from the well of Bethlehem, which is by
the gate!"
16 The three mighty men broke through
the army of the Philistines, and drew
water out of the well of Bethlehem that
was by the gate and took it and brought it
to David; but he would not drink of it, but
poured it out to Yahweh.
17 He said, "Be it far from me, Yahweh,
that I should do this! Isn't this the blood of
the men who risked their lives to go?"
Therefore he would not drink it. The
three mighty men did these things.
18 Abishai, the brother of Joab, the son
of Zeruiah, was chief of the three. He
lifted up his spear against three hundred
and killed them, and had a name among
the three.
19 Wasn't he most honorable of the
three? Therefore he was made their
captain. However he wasn't included as
one of the three.
20 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, the son
of a valiant man of Kabzeel, who had
done mighty deeds, killed the two sons of
Ariel of Moab. He also went down and
killed a lion in the middle of a pit in a time
of snow.
21 He killed a huge Egyptian, and the
Egyptian had a spear in his hand; but he
went down to him with a staff and
plucked the spear out of the Egyptian's
hand, and killed him with his own spear.
22 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada did these
things, and had a name among the three
mighty men.
23 He was more honorable than the
thirty, but he didn't attain to the three.
David set him over his guard.
24 Asahel the brother of Joab was one of
the thirty: Elhanan the son of Dodo of
Bethlehem,
25 Shammah the Harodite, Elika the
Harodite,
26 Helez the Paltite, Ira the son of Ikkesh
the Tekoite,
27 Abiezer the Anathothite, Mebunnai
the Hushathite,
28 Zalmon the Ahohite, Maharai the
Netophathite,
29 Heleb the son of Baanah the
Netophathite, Ittai the son of Ribai of
Gibeah of the children of Benjamin,
30 Benaiah a Pirathonite, Hiddai of the
brooks of Gaash.
31 Abialbon the Arbathite, Azmaveth the
Barhumite,
32 Eliahba the Shaalbonite, the sons of
Jashen, Jonathan,
33 Shammah the Hararite, Ahiam the
son of Sharar the Ararite,
34 Eliphelet the son of Ahasbai, the son
of the Maacathite, Eliam the son of
Ahithophel the Gilonite,
35 Hezro the Carmelite, Paarai the
Arbite,
36 Igal the son of Nathan of Zobah, Bani
the Gadite,

37 Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the
Beerothite, armor bearers to Joab the son
of Zeruiah,
38 Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite,
39 and Uriah the Hittite: thirty-seven in
all.

24

1 Again Yahweh's anger burned against
Israel, and he moved David against them,
saying, "Go, count Israel and Judah."
2 The king said to Joab the captain of the
army, who was with him, "Now go back
and forth through all the tribes of Israel,
from Dan even to Beersheba, and count
the people, that I may know the sum of the
people."
3 Joab said to the king, "Now may
Yahweh your God add to the people,
however many they may be, one hundred
times; and may the eyes of my lord the
king see it. But why does my lord the king
delight in this thing?"
4 Notwithstanding, the king's word
prevailed against Joab and against the
captains of the army. Joab and the
captains of the army went out from the
presence of the king to count the people of
Israel.
5 They passed over the Jordan and
encamped in Aroer, on the right side of
the city that is in the middle of the valley
of Gad, and to Jazer;
6 then they came to Gilead and to the
land of Tahtim Hodshi; and they came to
Dan Jaan and around to Sidon,
7 and came to the stronghold of Tyre,
and to all the cities of the Hivites and of
the Canaanites; and they went out to the
south of Judah, at Beersheba.
8 So when they had gone back and forth
through all the land, they came to
Jerusalem at the end of nine months and
twenty days.
9 Joab gave up the sum of the counting
of the people to the king; and there were
in Israel eight hundred thousand valiant
men who drew the sword, and the men of
Judah were five hundred thousand men.
10 David's heart struck him after he had
counted the people. David said to Yahweh,
"I have sinned greatly in that which I have
done. But now, Yahweh, put away, I beg
you, the iniquity of your servant; for I
have done very foolishly."
11 When David rose up in the morning,
Yahweh's word came to the prophet Gad,
David's seer, saying,
12 "Go and speak to David, 'Yahweh says,
"I offer you three things. Choose one of
them, that I may do it to you." ' "
13 So Gad came to David, and told him,
saying, "Shall seven years of famine come
to you in your land? Or will you flee three
months before your foes while they
pursue you? Or shall there be three days'
pestilence in your land? Now answer, and
consider what answer I shall return to
him who sent me."
14 David said to Gad, "I am in distress.
Let us fall now into Yahweh's hand, for his
mercies are great. Let me not fall into
man's hand."
15 So Yahweh sent a pestilence on Israel
from the morning even to the appointed
time; and seventy thousand men died of
the people from Dan even to Beersheba.
16 When the angel stretched out his
hand toward Jerusalem to destroy it,
Yahweh relented of the disaster, and said
to the angel who destroyed the people, "It
is enough. Now withdraw your hand."
Yahweh's angel was by the threshing floor
of Araunah the Jebusite.
17 David spoke to Yahweh when he saw
the angel who struck the people, and said,
"Behold, I have sinned, and I have done
perversely; but these sheep, what have
they done? Please let your hand be against
me, and against my father's house."
18 Gad came that day to David and said
to him, "Go up, build an altar to Yahweh
on the threshing floor of Araunah the
Jebusite."
19 David went up according to the
saying of Gad, as Yahweh commanded.
20 Araunah looked out, and saw the king
and his servants coming on toward him.
Then Araunah went out and bowed
himself before the king with his face to
the ground.

21 Araunah said, “Why has my lord the
king come to his servant?”
David said, “To buy your threshing
floor, to build an altar to Yahweh, that the
plague may be stopped from afflicting the
people.”
22 Araunah said to David, “Let my lord
the king take and offer up what seems
good to him. Behold, the cattle for the
burnt offering, and the threshing sledges
and the yokes of the oxen for the wood.
23 All this, O king, does Araunah give to
the king.” Araunah said to the king, “May
Yahweh your God accept you.”
24 The king said to Araunah, “No, but I
will most certainly buy it from you for a
price. I will not offer burnt offerings to
Yahweh my God which cost me nothing.”
So David bought the threshing floor and
the oxen for fifty shekels† of silver.
25 David built an altar to Yahweh there,
and offered burnt offerings and peace
offerings. So Yahweh was entreated for
the land, and the plague was removed
from Israel.

† **24:24** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 50 shekels is about 0.5 kilograms or 1.1 pounds.

The First Book of Kings

1 Now King David was old and advanced
in years; and they covered him with
clothes, but he couldn't keep warm.
2 Therefore his servants said to him,
"Let a young virgin be sought for my lord
the king. Let her stand before the king,
and cherish him; and let her lie in your
bosom, that my lord the king may keep
warm."
3 So they sought for a beautiful young
lady throughout all the borders of Israel,
and found Abishag the Shunammite, and
brought her to the king.
4 The young lady was very beautiful;
and she cherished the king, and served
him; but the king didn't know her
intimately.
5 Then Adonijah the son of Haggith
exalted himself, saying, "I will be king."
Then he prepared him chariots and
horsemen, and fifty men to run before
him.
6 His father had not displeased him at
any time in saying, "Why have you done
so?" and he was also a very handsome
man; and he was born after Absalom.
7 He conferred with Joab the son of
Zeruiah and with Abiathar the priest; and
they followed Adonijah and helped him.
8 But Zadok the priest, Benaiah the son
of Jehoiada, Nathan the prophet, Shimei,
Rei, and the mighty men who belonged to
David, were not with Adonijah.
9 Adonijah killed sheep, cattle, and
fatlings by the stone of Zoheleth, which is
beside En Rogel; and he called all his
brothers, the king's sons, and all the men
of Judah, the king's servants;
10 but he didn't call Nathan the prophet,
and Benaiah, and the mighty men, and
Solomon his brother.
11 Then Nathan spoke to Bathsheba the
mother of Solomon, saying, "Haven't you
heard that Adonijah the son of Haggith
reigns, and David our lord doesn't know
it?
12 Now therefore come, please let me
give you counsel, that you may save your
own life and your son Solomon's life.
13 Go in to King David, and tell him,
'Didn't you, my lord the king, swear to
your servant, saying, "Assuredly Solomon
your son shall reign after me, and he shall
sit on my throne"? Why then does
Adonijah reign?'
14 Behold,† while you are still talking
there with the king, I will also come in
after you and confirm your words."
15 Bathsheba went in to the king in his
room. The king was very old; and Abishag
the Shunammite was serving the king.
16 Bathsheba bowed and showed
respect to the king. The king said, "What
would you like?"
17 She said to him, "My lord, you swore
by Yahweh‡ your God§ to your servant,
'Assuredly Solomon your son shall reign
after me, and he shall sit on my throne.'
18 Now, behold, Adonijah reigns; and
you, my lord the king, don't know it.
19 He has slain cattle and fatlings and
sheep in abundance, and has called all the
sons of the king, Abiathar the priest, and
Joab the captain of the army; but he hasn't
called Solomon your servant.
20 You, my lord the king, the eyes of all
Israel are on you, that you should tell
them who will sit on the throne of my lord
the king after him.
21 Otherwise it will happen, when my
lord the king sleeps with his fathers, that I
and my son Solomon will be considered
criminals."
22 Behold, while she was still talking
with the king, Nathan the prophet came
in.
23 They told the king, saying, "Behold,
Nathan the prophet!"

When he had come in before the king,
he bowed himself before the king with his
face to the ground.

† **1:14** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

‡ **1:17** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. § **1:17** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

24 Nathan said, “My lord, King, have you
said, ‘Adonijah shall reign after me, and
he shall sit on my throne’?
25 For he has gone down today, and has
slain cattle, fatlings, and sheep in
abundance, and has called all the king’s
sons, the captains of the army, and
Abiathar the priest. Behold, they are
eating and drinking before him, and
saying, ‘Long live King Adonijah!’
26 But he hasn’t called me, even me your
servant, Zadok the priest, Benaiah the son
of Jehoiada, and your servant Solomon.
27 Was this thing done by my lord the
king, and you haven’t shown to your
servants who should sit on the throne of
my lord the king after him?”
28 Then King David answered, “Call
Bathsheba in to me.” She came into the
king’s presence and stood before the king.
29 The king vowed and said, “As Yahweh
lives, who has redeemed my soul out of all
adversity,
30 most certainly as I swore to you by
Yahweh, the God of Israel, saying,
‘Assuredly Solomon your son shall reign
after me, and he shall sit on my throne in
my place;’ I will most certainly do this
today.”
31 Then Bathsheba bowed with her face
to the earth and showed respect to the
king, and said, “Let my lord King David
live forever!”
32 King David said, “Call to me Zadok the
priest, Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah
the son of Jehoiada.” They came before
the king.
33 The king said to them, “Take with you
the servants of your lord, and cause
Solomon my son to ride on my own mule,
and bring him down to Gihon.
34 Let Zadok the priest and Nathan the
prophet anoint him there king over Israel.
Blow the trumpet, and say, ‘Long live King
Solomon!’
35 Then come up after him, and he shall
come and sit on my throne; for he shall be
king in my place. I have appointed him to
be prince over Israel and over Judah.”
36 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada answered
the king, and said, “Amen. May Yahweh,
the God of my lord the king, say so.
37 As Yahweh has been with my lord the
king, even so may he be with Solomon,
and make his throne greater than the
throne of my lord King David.”
38 So Zadok the priest, Nathan the
prophet, Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and
the Cherethites and the Pelethites went
down and had Solomon ride on King
David’s mule, and brought him to Gihon.
39 Zadok the priest took the horn of oil
from the Tent, and anointed Solomon.
They blew the trumpet; and all the people
said, “Long live King Solomon!”
40 All the people came up after him, and
the people piped with pipes, and rejoiced
with great joy, so that the earth shook
with their sound.
41 Adonijah and all the guests who were
with him heard it as they had finished
eating. When Joab heard the sound of the
trumpet, he said, “Why is this noise of the
city being in an uproar?”
42 While he yet spoke, behold, Jonathan
the son of Abiathar the priest came; and
Adonijah said, “Come in; for you are a
worthy man, and bring good news.”
43 Jonathan answered Adonijah, “Most
certainly our lord King David has made
Solomon king.
44 The king has sent with him Zadok the
priest, Nathan the prophet, Benaiah the
son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites and
the Pelethites; and they have caused him
to ride on the king’s mule.
45 Zadok the priest and Nathan the
prophet have anointed him king in Gihon.
They have come up from there rejoicing,
so that the city rang again. This is the
noise that you have heard.
46 Also, Solomon sits on the throne of
the kingdom.
47 Moreover the king’s servants came to
bless our lord King David, saying, ‘May
your God make the name of Solomon
better than your name, and make his
throne greater than your throne;’ and the
king bowed himself on the bed.
48 Also thus said the king, ‘Blessed be
Yahweh, the God of Israel, who has given

one to sit on my throne today, my eyes even seeing it.' "
49 All the guests of Adonijah were afraid, and rose up, and each man went his way.
50 Adonijah was afraid because of Solomon; and he arose, and went, and hung onto the horns of the altar.
51 Solomon was told, "Behold, Adonijah fears King Solomon; for, behold, he is hanging onto the horns of the altar, saying, 'Let King Solomon swear to me first that he will not kill his servant with the sword.' "
52 Solomon said, "If he shows himself a worthy man, not a hair of his shall fall to the earth; but if wickedness is found in him, he shall die."
53 So King Solomon sent, and they brought him down from the altar. He came and bowed down to King Solomon; and Solomon said to him, "Go to your house."

2

1 Now the days of David came near that he should die; and he commanded Solomon his son, saying,
2 "I am going the way of all the earth. You be strong therefore, and show yourself a man;
3 and keep the instruction of Yahweh your God, to walk in his ways, to keep his statutes, his commandments, his ordinances, and his testimonies, according to that which is written in the law of Moses, that you may prosper in all that you do and wherever you turn yourself.
4 Then Yahweh may establish his word which he spoke concerning me, saying, 'If your children are careful of their way, to walk before me in truth with all their heart and with all their soul, there shall not fail you,' he said, 'a man on the throne of Israel.'
5 "Moreover you know also what Joab the son of Zeruiah did to me, even what he did to the two captains of the armies of Israel, to Abner the son of Ner and to Amasa the son of Jether, whom he killed, and shed the blood of war in peace, and put the blood of war on his sash that was around his waist and in his sandals that were on his feet.
6 Do therefore according to your wisdom, and don't let his gray head go down to Sheol† in peace.
7 But show kindness to the sons of Barzillai the Gileadite, and let them be among those who eat at your table; for so they came to me when I fled from Absalom your brother.
8 "Behold, there is with you Shimei the son of Gera, the Benjamite of Bahurim, who cursed me with a grievous curse in the day when I went to Mahanaim; but he came down to meet me at the Jordan, and I swore to him by Yahweh, saying, 'I will not put you to death with the sword.'
9 Now therefore don't hold him guiltless, for you are a wise man; and you will know what you ought to do to him, and you shall bring his gray head down to Sheol‡ with blood."
10 David slept with his fathers, and was buried in David's city.
11 The days that David reigned over Israel were forty years; he reigned seven years in Hebron, and he reigned thirty-three years in Jerusalem.
12 Solomon sat on David his father's throne; and his kingdom was firmly established.
13 Then Adonijah the son of Haggith came to Bathsheba the mother of Solomon. She said, "Do you come peaceably?"

He said, "Peaceably.
14 He said moreover, I have something to tell you."

She said, "Say on."

15 He said, "You know that the kingdom was mine, and that all Israel set their faces on me, that I should reign. However, the kingdom is turned around, and has become my brother's; for it was his from Yahweh.
16 Now I ask one petition of you. Don't deny me."

She said to him, "Say on."

† **2:6** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **2:9** Sheol is the place of the dead.

17 He said, “Please speak to Solomon the
king (for he will not tell you ‘no’), that he
give me Abishag the Shunammite as
wife.”
18 Bathsheba said, “All right. I will speak
for you to the king.”
19 Bathsheba therefore went to King
Solomon, to speak to him for Adonijah.
The king rose up to meet her and bowed
himself to her, and sat down on his throne
and caused a throne to be set for the king’s
mother; and she sat on his right hand.
20 Then she said, “I ask one small
petition of you; don’t deny me.”
The king said to her, “Ask on, my
mother, for I will not deny you.”
21 She said, “Let Abishag the
Shunammite be given to Adonijah your
brother as wife.”
22 King Solomon answered his mother,
“Why do you ask Abishag the Shunammite
for Adonijah? Ask for him the kingdom
also, for he is my elder brother; even for
him, and for Abiathar the priest, and for
Joab the son of Zeruiah.”
23 Then King Solomon swore by
Yahweh, saying, “God do so to me, and
more also, if Adonijah has not spoken this
word against his own life.
24 Now therefore as Yahweh lives, who
has established me and set me on my
father David’s throne, and who has made
me a house as he promised, surely
Adonijah shall be put to death today.”
25 King Solomon sent Benaiah the son of
Jehoiada; and he fell on him, so that he
died.
26 To Abiathar the priest the king said,
“Go to Anathoth, to your own fields, for
you are worthy of death. But I will not at
this time put you to death, because you
bore the Lord§ Yahweh’s ark before David
my father, and because you were afflicted
in all in which my father was afflicted.”
27 So Solomon thrust Abiathar out from
being priest to Yahweh, that he might
fulfill Yahweh’s word which he spoke
concerning the house of Eli in Shiloh.
28 This news came to Joab; for Joab had
followed Adonijah, although he didn’t
follow Absalom. Joab fled to Yahweh’s
Tent, and held onto the horns of the altar.
29 King Solomon was told, “Joab has fled
to Yahweh’s Tent; and behold, he is by the
altar.” Then Solomon sent Benaiah the
son of Jehoiada, saying, “Go, fall on him.”
30 Benaiah came to Yahweh’s Tent, and
said to him, “The king says, ‘Come out!’ ”
He said, “No; but I will die here.”
Benaiah brought the king word again,
saying, “This is what Joab said, and this is
how he answered me.”
31 The king said to him, “Do as he has
said, and fall on him, and bury him, that
you may take away the blood, which Joab
shed without cause, from me and from my
father’s house.
32 Yahweh will return his blood on his
own head, because he fell on two men
more righteous and better than he, and
killed them with the sword, and my father
David didn’t know it: Abner the son of
Ner, captain of the army of Israel, and
Amasa the son of Jether, captain of the
army of Judah.
33 So their blood will return on the head
of Joab and on the head of his offspring†
forever. But for David, for his offspring,
for his house, and for his throne, there
will be peace forever from Yahweh.”
34 Then Benaiah the son of Jehoiada
went up and fell on him, and killed him;
and he was buried in his own house in the
wilderness.
35 The king put Benaiah the son of
Jehoiada in his place over the army; and
the king put Zadok the priest in the place
of Abiathar.
36 The king sent and called for Shimei,
and said to him, “Build yourself a house in
Jerusalem, and live there, and don’t go
anywhere else.
37 For on the day you go out and pass
over the brook Kidron, know for certain
that you will surely die. Your blood will be
on your own head.”
38 Shimei said to the king, “What you say
is good. As my lord the king has said, so
will your servant do.” Shimei lived in
Jerusalem many days.

§ **2:26** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai.” † **2:33** or, seed

39 At the end of three years, two of
Shimei's slaves ran away to Achish, son of
Maacah, king of Gath. They told Shimei,
saying, "Behold, your slaves are in Gath."
40 Shimei arose, saddled his donkey, and
went to Gath to Achish to seek his slaves;
and Shimei went and brought his slaves
from Gath.
41 Solomon was told that Shimei had
gone from Jerusalem to Gath, and had
come again.
42 The king sent and called for Shimei,
and said to him, "Didn't I adjure you by
Yahweh and warn you, saying, 'Know for
certain that on the day you go out and
walk anywhere else, you shall surely die'?
You said to me, 'The saying that I have
heard is good.'
43 Why then have you not kept the oath
of Yahweh and the commandment that I
have instructed you with?"
44 The king said moreover to Shimei,
"You know in your heart all the
wickedness that you did to David my
father. Therefore Yahweh will return
your wickedness on your own head.
45 But King Solomon will be blessed, and
David's throne will be established before
Yahweh forever."
46 So the king commanded Benaiah the
son of Jehoiada; and he went out, and fell
on him, so that he died. The kingdom was
established in the hand of Solomon.

3

1 Solomon made a marriage alliance
with Pharaoh king of Egypt. He took
Pharaoh's daughter and brought her into
David's city until he had finished building
his own house, Yahweh's house, and the
wall around Jerusalem.
2 However, the people sacrificed in the
high places, because there was not yet a
house built for Yahweh's name.
3 Solomon loved Yahweh, walking in the
statutes of David his father, except that he
sacrificed and burned incense in the high
places.
4 The king went to Gibeon to sacrifice
there, for that was the great high place.
Solomon offered a thousand burnt
offerings on that altar.
5 In Gibeon, Yahweh appeared to
Solomon in a dream by night; and God
said, "Ask for what I should give you."
6 Solomon said, "You have shown to
your servant David my father great loving
kindness, because he walked before you
in truth, in righteousness, and in
uprightness of heart with you. You have
kept for him this great loving kindness,
that you have given him a son to sit on his
throne, as it is today.
7 Now, Yahweh my God, you have made
your servant king instead of David my
father. I am just a little child. I don't know
how to go out or come in.
8 Your servant is among your people
which you have chosen, a great people,
that can't be numbered or counted for
multitude.
9 Give your servant therefore an
understanding heart to judge your people,
that I may discern between good and evil;
for who is able to judge this great people
of yours?"
10 This request pleased the Lord, that
Solomon had asked this thing.
11 God said to him, "Because you have
asked this thing, and have not asked for
yourself long life, nor have you asked for
riches for yourself, nor have you asked for
the life of your enemies, but have asked
for yourself understanding to discern
justice,
12 behold, I have done according to your
word. Behold, I have given you a wise and
understanding heart, so that there has
been no one like you before you, and after
you none will arise like you.
13 I have also given you that which you
have not asked, both riches and honor, so
that there will not be any among the kings
like you for all your days.
14 If you will walk in my ways, to keep
my statutes and my commandments, as
your father David walked, then I will
lengthen your days."
15 Solomon awoke; and behold, it was a
dream. Then he came to Jerusalem and
stood before the ark of Yahweh's
covenant, and offered up burnt offerings,

offered peace offerings, and made a feast for all his servants.
16 Then two women who were prostitutes came to the king, and stood before him.
17 The one woman said, “Oh, my lord, I and this woman dwell in one house. I delivered a child with her in the house.
18 The third day after I delivered, this woman delivered also. We were together. There was no stranger with us in the house, just us two in the house.
19 This woman’s child died in the night, because she lay on it.
20 She arose at midnight, and took my son from beside me while your servant slept, and laid it in her bosom, and laid her dead child in my bosom.
21 When I rose in the morning to nurse my child, behold, he was dead; but when I had looked at him in the morning, behold, it was not my son whom I bore.”
22 The other woman said, “No! But the living one is my son, and the dead one is your son.”
The first one said, “No! But the dead one is your son, and the living one is my son.” They argued like this before the king.
23 Then the king said, “One says, ‘This is my son who lives, and your son is the dead one;’ and the other says, ‘No! But your son is the dead one, and my son is the living one.’ ”
24 The king said, “Get me a sword.” So they brought a sword before the king.
25 The king said, “Divide the living child in two, and give half to the one, and half to the other.”
26 Then the woman whose the living child was spoke to the king, for her heart yearned over her son, and she said, “Oh, my lord, give her the living child, and in no way kill him!”
But the other said, “He shall be neither mine nor yours. Divide him.”
27 Then the king answered, “Give the first woman the living child, and definitely do not kill him. She is his mother.”
28 All Israel heard of the judgment which the king had judged; and they feared the king, for they saw that the wisdom of God was in him to do justice.

4

1 King Solomon was king over all Israel.
2 These were the princes whom he had: Azariah the son of Zadok, the priest;
3 Elihoreph and Ahijah, the sons of Shisha, scribes; Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud, the recorder;
4 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the army; Zadok and Abiathar were priests;
5 Azariah the son of Nathan was over the officers; Zabud the son of Nathan was chief minister, the king’s friend;
6 Ahishar was over the household; and Adoniram the son of Abda was over the men subject to forced labor.
7 Solomon had twelve officers over all Israel, who provided food for the king and his household. Each man had to make provision for a month in the year.
8 These are their names: Ben Hur, in the hill country of Ephraim;
9 Ben Deker, in Makaz, in Shaalbim, Beth Shemesh, and Elon Beth Hanan;
10 Ben Hesed, in Arubboth (Socoh and all the land of Hepher belonged to him);
11 Ben Abinadab, in all the height of Dor (he had Taphath, Solomon’s daughter, as wife);
12 Baana the son of Ahilud, in Taanach and Megiddo, and all Beth Shean which is beside Zarethan, beneath Jezreel, from Beth Shean to Abel Meholah, as far as beyond Jokmeam;
13 Ben Geber, in Ramoth Gilead (the towns of Jair the son of Manasseh, which are in Gilead, belonged to him; and the region of Argob, which is in Bashan, sixty great cities with walls and bronze bars, belonged to him);
14 Ahinadab the son of Iddo, in Mahanaim;
15 Ahimaaz, in Naphtali (he also took Basemath the daughter of Solomon as wife);
16 Baana the son of Hushai, in Asher and Bealoth;
17 Jehoshaphat the son of Paruah, in Issachar;

18 Shimei the son of Ela, in Benjamin;
19 Geber the son of Uri, in the land of Gilead, the country of Sihon king of the Amorites and of Og king of Bashan; and he was the only officer who was in the land.
20 Judah and Israel were numerous as the sand which is by the sea in multitude, eating and drinking and making merry.
21 Solomon ruled over all the kingdoms from the River to the land of the Philistines, and to the border of Egypt. They brought tribute and served Solomon all the days of his life.
22 Solomon's provision for one day was thirty cors† of fine flour, sixty measures of meal,
23 ten head of fat cattle, twenty head of cattle out of the pastures, and one hundred sheep, in addition to deer, gazelles, roebucks, and fattened fowl.
24 For he had dominion over all on this side of the River, from Tiphsah even to Gaza, over all the kings on this side of the River; and he had peace on all sides around him.
25 Judah and Israel lived safely, every man under his vine and under his fig tree, from Dan even to Beersheba, all the days of Solomon.
26 Solomon had forty thousand stalls of horses for his chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen.
27 Those officers provided food for King Solomon, and for all who came to King Solomon's table, every man in his month. They let nothing be lacking.
28 They also brought barley and straw for the horses and swift steeds to the place where the officers were, each man according to his duty.
29 God gave Solomon abundant wisdom, understanding, and breadth of mind like the sand that is on the seashore.
30 Solomon's wisdom excelled the wisdom of all the children of the east and all the wisdom of Egypt.
31 For he was wiser than all men—wiser than Ethan the Ezrahite, Heman, Calcol, and Darda, the sons of Mahol; and his fame was in all the nations all around.
32 He spoke three thousand proverbs, and his songs numbered one thousand five.
33 He spoke of trees, from the cedar that is in Lebanon even to the hyssop that grows out of the wall; he also spoke of animals, of birds, of creeping things, and of fish.
34 People of all nations came to hear the wisdom of Solomon, sent by all kings of the earth who had heard of his wisdom.

5

1 Hiram king of Tyre sent his servants to Solomon, for he had heard that they had anointed him king in the place of his father, and Hiram had always loved David.
2 Solomon sent to Hiram, saying,
3 "You know that David my father could not build a house for the name of Yahweh his God because of the wars which were around him on every side, until Yahweh put his enemies under the soles of his feet.
4 But now Yahweh my God has given me rest on every side. There is no enemy and no evil occurrence.
5 Behold, I intend to build a house for the name of Yahweh my God, as Yahweh spoke to David my father, saying, 'Your son, whom I will set on your throne in your place shall build the house for my name.'
6 Now therefore command that cedar trees be cut for me out of Lebanon. My servants will be with your servants; and I will give you wages for your servants according to all that you say. For you know that there is nobody among us who knows how to cut timber like the Sidonians."
7 When Hiram heard the words of Solomon, he rejoiced greatly, and said, "Blessed is Yahweh today, who has given to David a wise son to rule over this great people."
8 Hiram sent to Solomon, saying, "I have heard the message which you have sent to me. I will do all your desire concerning timber of cedar, and concerning cypress timber.

† **4:22** 1 cor is the same as a homer, or about 55.9 U. S. gallons (liquid) or 211 liters or 6 bushels

9 My servants will bring them down
from Lebanon to the sea. I will make them
into rafts to go by sea to the place that you
specify to me, and will cause them to be
broken up there, and you will receive
them. You will accomplish my desire, in
giving food for my household."
10 So Hiram gave Solomon cedar timber
and cypress timber according to all his
desire.
11 Solomon gave Hiram twenty
thousand cors† of wheat for food to his
household, and twenty cors‡ of pure oil.
Solomon gave this to Hiram year by year.
12 Yahweh gave Solomon wisdom, as he
promised him. There was peace between
Hiram and Solomon, and the two of them
made a treaty together.
13 King Solomon raised a levy out of all
Israel; and the levy was thirty thousand
men.
14 He sent them to Lebanon, ten
thousand a month by courses: for a
month they were in Lebanon, and two
months at home; and Adoniram was over
the men subject to forced labor.
15 Solomon had seventy thousand who
bore burdens, and eighty thousand who
were stone cutters in the mountains,
16 besides Solomon's chief officers who
were over the work: three thousand three
hundred who ruled over the people who
labored in the work.
17 The king commanded, and they cut
out large stones, costly stones, to lay the
foundation of the house with worked
stone.
18 Solomon's builders and Hiram's
builders and the Gebalites cut them, and
prepared the timber and the stones to
build the house.

6

1 In the four hundred and eightieth year
after the children of Israel had come out
of the land of Egypt, in the fourth year of
Solomon's reign over Israel, in the month
Ziv, which is the second month, he began
to build Yahweh's house.
2 The house which King Solomon built
for Yahweh had a length of sixty cubits,†
and its width twenty, and its height thirty
cubits.
3 The porch in front of the temple of the
house had a length of twenty cubits,
which was along the width of the house.
Ten cubits was its width in front of the
house.
4 He made windows of fixed lattice
work for the house.
5 Against the wall of the house, he built
floors all around, against the walls of the
house all around, both of the temple and
of the inner sanctuary; and he made side
rooms all around.
6 The lowest floor was five cubits wide,
and the middle was six cubits wide, and
the third was seven cubits wide; for on the
outside he made offsets in the wall of the
house all around, that the beams should
not be inserted into the walls of the house.
7 The house, when it was under
construction, was built of stone prepared
at the quarry; and no hammer or ax or
any tool of iron was heard in the house
while it was under construction.
8 The door for the middle side rooms
was in the right side of the house. They
went up by winding stairs into the middle
floor, and out of the middle into the third.
9 So he built the house and finished it;
and he covered the house with beams and
planks of cedar.
10 He built the floors all along the house,
each five cubits high; and they rested on
the house with timbers of cedar.
11 Yahweh's word came to Solomon,
saying,
12 "Concerning this house which you are
building, if you will walk in my statutes,
and execute my ordinances, and keep all
my commandments to walk in them, then
I will establish my word with you, which I
spoke to David your father.
13 I will dwell among the children of
Israel, and will not forsake my people
Israel."
14 So Solomon built the house and
finished it.

† **5:11** 20,000 cors would be about 120,000 bushels or about 4.2 megaliters of wheat, which would weigh about 3,270 metric tons. ‡ **5:11** 20 cors is about 1,100 gallons or about 4220 liters. † **6:2** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

15 He built the walls of the house within
with boards of cedar; from the floor of the
house to the walls of the ceiling, he
covered them on the inside with wood. He
covered the floor of the house with
cypress boards.
16 He built twenty cubits of the back
part of the house with boards of cedar
from the floor to the ceiling. He built this
within, for an inner sanctuary, even for
the most holy place.
17 In front of the temple sanctuary was
forty cubits long.
18 There was cedar on the house within,
carved with buds and open flowers. All
was cedar. No stone was visible.
19 He prepared an inner sanctuary in
the middle of the house within, to set the
ark of Yahweh's covenant there.
20 Within the inner sanctuary was
twenty cubits in length, and twenty cubits
in width, and twenty cubits in its height.
He overlaid it with pure gold. He covered
the altar with cedar.
21 So Solomon overlaid the house within
with pure gold. He drew chains of gold
across before the inner sanctuary, and he
overlaid it with gold.
22 He overlaid the whole house with
gold, until all the house was finished. He
also overlaid the whole altar that
belonged to the inner sanctuary with gold.

23 In the inner sanctuary he made two
cherubim‡ of olive wood, each ten cubits
high.
24 Five cubits was the length of one wing
of the cherub, and five cubits was the
length of the other wing of the cherub.
From the tip of one wing to the tip of the
other was ten cubits.
25 The other cherub was ten cubits. Both
the cherubim were of one measure and
one form.
26 One cherub was ten cubits high, and
so was the other cherub.
27 He set the cherubim within the inner
house. The wings of the cherubim were
stretched out, so that the wing of the one
touched the one wall and the wing of the
other cherub touched the other wall; and
their wings touched one another in the
middle of the house.
28 He overlaid the cherubim with gold.

29 He carved all the walls of the house
around with carved figures of cherubim,
palm trees, and open flowers, inside and
outside.
30 He overlaid the floor of the house
with gold, inside and outside.
31 For the entrance of the inner
sanctuary, he made doors of olive wood.
The lintel and door posts were a fifth part
of the wall.
32 So he made two doors of olive wood;
and he carved on them carvings of
cherubim, palm trees, and open flowers,
and overlaid them with gold. He spread
the gold on the cherubim and on the palm
trees.
33 He also made the entrance of the
temple door posts of olive wood, out of a
fourth part of the wall,
34 and two doors of cypress wood. The
two leaves of the one door were folding,
and the two leaves of the other door were
folding.
35 He carved cherubim, palm trees, and
open flowers; and he overlaid them with
gold fitted on the engraved work.
36 He built the inner court with three
courses of cut stone and a course of cedar
beams.
37 The foundation of Yahweh's house
was laid in the fourth year, in the month
Ziv.
38 In the eleventh year, in the month
Bul, which is the eighth month, the house
was finished throughout all its parts and
according to all its specifications. So he
spent seven years building it.

7

1 Solomon was building his own house
thirteen years, and he finished all his
house.
2 For he built the House of the Forest of
Lebanon. Its length was one hundred
cubits,† its width fifty cubits, and its
height thirty cubits, on four rows of cedar
pillars, with cedar beams on the pillars.

‡ **6:23** "Cherubim" is plural of "cherub", an angelic being. † **7:2** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

3 It was covered with cedar above over
the forty-five beams that were on the
pillars, fifteen in a row.
4 There were beams in three rows, and
window was facing window in three
ranks.
5 All the doors and posts were made
square with beams; and window was
facing window in three ranks.
6 He made the hall of pillars. Its length
was fifty cubits and its width thirty cubits,
with a porch before them, and pillars and
a threshold before them.
7 He made the porch of the throne
where he was to judge, even the porch of
judgment; and it was covered with cedar
from floor to floor.
8 His house where he was to dwell, the
other court within the porch, was of the
same construction. He made also a house
for Pharaoh's daughter (whom Solomon
had taken as wife), like this porch.
9 All these were of costly stones, even of
stone cut according to measure, sawed
with saws, inside and outside, even from
the foundation to the coping, and so on
the outside to the great court.
10 The foundation was of costly stones,
even great stones, stones of ten cubits and
stones of eight cubits.
11 Above were costly stones, even cut
stone, according to measure, and cedar
wood.
12 The great court around had three
courses of cut stone with a course of cedar
beams, like the inner court of Yahweh's
house and the porch of the house.

13 King Solomon sent and brought
Hiram out of Tyre.
14 He was the son of a widow of the tribe
of Naphtali, and his father was a man of
Tyre, a worker in bronze; and he was
filled with wisdom and understanding
and skill to work all works in bronze. He
came to King Solomon and performed all
his work.
15 For he fashioned the two pillars of
bronze, eighteen cubits high apiece; and a
line of twelve cubits encircled either of
them.
16 He made two capitals of molten
bronze to set on the tops of the pillars. The
height of the one capital was five cubits,
and the height of the other capital was
five cubits.
17 There were nets of checker work and
wreaths of chain work for the capitals
which were on the top of the pillars:
seven for the one capital, and seven for
the other capital.
18 So he made the pillars; and there
were two rows of pomegranates around
the one network, to cover the capitals that
were on the top of the pillars; and he did
so for the other capital.
19 The capitals that were on the top of
the pillars in the porch were of lily work,
four cubits.
20 There were capitals above also on the
two pillars, close by the belly which was
beside the network. There were two
hundred pomegranates in rows around
the other capital.
21 He set up the pillars at the porch of
the temple. He set up the right pillar and
called its name Jachin; and he set up the
left pillar and called its name Boaz.
22 On the tops of the pillars was lily
work. So the work of the pillars was
finished.
23 He made the molten sea ten cubits
from brim to brim, round in shape. Its
height was five cubits; and a line of thirty
cubits encircled it.
24 Under its brim around there were
buds which encircled it for ten cubits,
encircling the sea. The buds were in two
rows, cast when it was cast.
25 It stood on twelve oxen, three looking
toward the north, and three looking
toward the west, and three looking
toward the south, and three looking
toward the east; and the sea was set on
them above, and all their hindquarters
were inward.
26 It was a hand width thick. Its brim
was worked like the brim of a cup, like the
flower of a lily. It held two thousand
baths.
27 He made the ten bases of bronze. The
length of one base was four cubits, four
cubits its width, and three cubits its
height.
28 The work of the bases was like this:
they had panels; and there were panels

between the ledges;
29 and on the panels that were between
the ledges were lions, oxen, and
cherubim; and on the ledges there was a
pedestal above; and beneath the lions and
oxen were wreaths of hanging work.
30 Every base had four bronze wheels
and axles of bronze; and its four feet had
supports. The supports were cast beneath
the basin, with wreaths at the side of each.
31 Its opening within the capital and
above was a cubit. Its opening was round
like the work of a pedestal, a cubit and a
half; and also on its opening were
engravings, and their panels were square,
not round.
32 The four wheels were underneath the
panels; and the axles of the wheels were
in the base. The height of a wheel was a
cubit and half a cubit.
33 The work of the wheels was like the
work of a chariot wheel. Their axles, their
rims, their spokes, and their hubs were all
of cast metal.
34 There were four supports at the four
corners of each base. Its supports were of
the base itself.
35 In the top of the base there was a
round band half a cubit high; and on the
top of the base its supports and its panels
were the same.
36 On the plates of its supports and on its
panels, he engraved cherubim, lions, and
palm trees, each in its space, with wreaths
all around.
37 He made the ten bases in this way: all
of them had one casting, one measure,
and one form.
38 He made ten basins of bronze. One
basin contained forty baths.‡ Every basin
measured four cubits. One basin was on
every one of the ten bases.
39 He set the bases, five on the right side
of the house and five on the left side of the
house. He set the sea on the right side of
the house eastward and toward the south.
40 Hiram made the pots, the shovels,
and the basins. So Hiram finished doing
all the work that he worked for King
Solomon in Yahweh's house:
41 the two pillars; the two bowls of the
capitals that were on the top of the pillars;
the two networks to cover the two bowls
of the capitals that were on the top of the
pillars;
42 the four hundred pomegranates for
the two networks; two rows of
pomegranates for each network, to cover
the two bowls of the capitals that were on
the pillars;
43 the ten bases; the ten basins on the
bases;
44 the one sea; the twelve oxen under
the sea;
45 the pots; the shovels; and the basins.
All of these vessels, which Hiram made
for King Solomon for Yahweh's house,
were of burnished bronze.
46 The king cast them in the plain of the
Jordan, in the clay ground between
Succoth and Zarethan.
47 Solomon left all the vessels
unweighed, because there were so many
of them. The weight of the bronze could
not be determined.
48 Solomon made all the vessels that
were in Yahweh's house: the golden altar
and the table that the show bread was on,
of gold;
49 and the lamp stands, five on the right
side and five on the left, in front of the
inner sanctuary, of pure gold; and the
flowers, the lamps, and the tongs, of gold;
50 the cups, the snuffers, the basins, the
spoons, and the fire pans, of pure gold;
and the hinges, both for the doors of the
inner house, the most holy place, and for
the doors of the house, of the temple, of
gold.
51 Thus all the work that King Solomon
did in Yahweh's house was finished.
Solomon brought in the things which
David his father had dedicated—the silver,
the gold, and the vessels—and put them in
the treasuries of Yahweh's house.

8

1 Then Solomon assembled the elders of
Israel with all the heads of the tribes, the
princes of the fathers' households of the
children of Israel, to King Solomon in

‡ **7:38** 1 bath is one tenth of a cor, or about 5.6 U. S. gallons or 21 liters, so 40 baths was about 224 gallons or 840 liters.

Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of Yahweh's covenant out of David's city, which is Zion.
2 All the men of Israel assembled themselves to King Solomon at the feast in the month Ethanim, which is the seventh month.
3 All the elders of Israel came, and the priests picked up the ark.
4 They brought up Yahweh's ark, the Tent of Meeting, and all the holy vessels that were in the Tent. The priests and the Levites brought these up.
5 King Solomon and all the congregation of Israel, who were assembled to him, were with him before the ark, sacrificing sheep and cattle that could not be counted or numbered for multitude.
6 The priests brought in the ark of Yahweh's covenant to its place, into the inner sanctuary of the house, to the most holy place, even under the cherubim's wings.
7 For the cherubim spread their wings out over the place of the ark, and the cherubim covered the ark and its poles above.
8 The poles were so long that the ends of the poles were seen from the holy place before the inner sanctuary, but they were not seen outside. They are there to this day.
9 There was nothing in the ark except the two stone tablets which Moses put there at Horeb, when Yahweh made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of the land of Egypt.
10 It came to pass, when the priests had come out of the holy place, that the cloud filled Yahweh's house,
11 so that the priests could not stand to minister by reason of the cloud; for Yahweh's glory filled Yahweh's house.
12 Then Solomon said, "Yahweh has said that he would dwell in the thick darkness.
13 I have surely built you a house of habitation, a place for you to dwell in forever."
14 The king turned his face around and blessed all the assembly of Israel; and all the assembly of Israel stood.
15 He said, "Blessed is Yahweh, the God of Israel, who spoke with his mouth to David your father, and has with his hand fulfilled it, saying,
16 'Since the day that I brought my people Israel out of Egypt, I chose no city out of all the tribes of Israel to build a house, that my name might be there; but I chose David to be over my people Israel.'
17 "Now it was in the heart of David my father to build a house for the name of Yahweh, the God of Israel.
18 But Yahweh said to David my father, 'Whereas it was in your heart to build a house for my name, you did well that it was in your heart.
19 Nevertheless, you shall not build the house; but your son who shall come out of your body, he shall build the house for my name.'
20 Yahweh has established his word that he spoke; for I have risen up in the place of David my father, and I sit on the throne of Israel, as Yahweh promised, and have built the house for the name of Yahweh, the God of Israel.
21 There I have set a place for the ark, in which is Yahweh's covenant, which he made with our fathers when he brought them out of the land of Egypt."
22 Solomon stood before Yahweh's altar in the presence of all the assembly of Israel, and spread out his hands toward heaven;
23 and he said, "Yahweh, the God of Israel, there is no God like you, in heaven above, or on earth beneath; who keeps covenant and loving kindness with your servants who walk before you with all their heart;
24 who has kept with your servant David my father that which you promised him. Yes, you spoke with your mouth, and have fulfilled it with your hand, as it is today.
25 Now therefore, may Yahweh, the God of Israel, keep with your servant David my father that which you have promised him, saying, 'There shall not fail from you a man in my sight to sit on the throne of Israel, if only your children take heed to their way, to walk before me as you have walked before me.'
26 "Now therefore, God of Israel, please let your word be verified, which you

spoke to your servant David my father.
27 But will God in very deed dwell on the
earth? Behold, heaven and the heaven of
heavens can't contain you; how much less
this house that I have built!
28 Yet have respect for the prayer of
your servant and for his supplication,
Yahweh my God, to listen to the cry and to
the prayer which your servant prays
before you today;
29 that your eyes may be open toward
this house night and day, even toward the
place of which you have said, 'My name
shall be there;' to listen to the prayer
which your servant prays toward this
place.
30 Listen to the supplication of your
servant, and of your people Israel, when
they pray toward this place. Yes, hear in
heaven, your dwelling place; and when
you hear, forgive.
31 "If a man sins against his neighbor,
and an oath is laid on him to cause him to
swear, and he comes and swears before
your altar in this house,
32 then hear in heaven, and act, and
judge your servants, condemning the
wicked, to bring his way on his own head,
and justifying the righteous, to give him
according to his righteousness.
33 "When your people Israel are struck
down before the enemy because they
have sinned against you, if they turn
again to you and confess your name, and
pray and make supplication to you in this
house,
34 then hear in heaven, and forgive the
sin of your people Israel, and bring them
again to the land which you gave to their
fathers.
35 "When the sky is shut up and there is
no rain because they have sinned against
you, if they pray toward this place and
confess your name, and turn from their
sin when you afflict them,
36 then hear in heaven, and forgive the
sin of your servants, and of your people
Israel, when you teach them the good way
in which they should walk; and send rain
on your land which you have given to
your people for an inheritance.
37 "If there is famine in the land, if there
is pestilence, if there is blight, mildew,
locust or caterpillar; if their enemy
besieges them in the land of their cities,
whatever plague, whatever sickness there
is,
38 whatever prayer and supplication is
made by any man, or by all your people
Israel, who shall each know the plague of
his own heart, and spread out his hands
toward this house,
39 then hear in heaven, your dwelling
place, and forgive, and act, and give to
every man according to all his ways,
whose heart you know (for you, even you
only, know the hearts of all the children of
men);
40 that they may fear you all the days
that they live in the land which you gave
to our fathers.
41 "Moreover, concerning the foreigner,
who is not of your people Israel, when he
comes out of a far country for your
name's sake
42 (for they shall hear of your great
name and of your mighty hand and of
your outstretched arm), when he comes
and prays toward this house,
43 hear in heaven, your dwelling place,
and do according to all that the foreigner
calls to you for; that all the peoples of the
earth may know your name, to fear you,
as do your people Israel, and that they
may know that this house which I have
built is called by your name.
44 "If your people go out to battle against
their enemy, by whatever way you shall
send them, and they pray to Yahweh
toward the city which you have chosen,
and toward the house which I have built
for your name,
45 then hear in heaven their prayer and
their supplication, and maintain their
cause.
46 If they sin against you (for there is no
man who doesn't sin), and you are angry
with them and deliver them to the enemy,
so that they carry them away captive to
the land of the enemy, far off or near;
47 yet if they repent in the land where
they are carried captive, and turn again,

and make supplication to you in the land of those who carried them captive, saying, ‘We have sinned and have done perversely; we have dealt wickedly,’
48 if they return to you with all their heart and with all their soul in the land of their enemies who carried them captive, and pray to you toward their land which you gave to their fathers, the city which you have chosen and the house which I have built for your name,
49 then hear their prayer and their supplication in heaven, your dwelling place, and maintain their cause;
50 and forgive your people who have sinned against you, and all their transgressions in which they have transgressed against you; and give them compassion before those who carried them captive, that they may have compassion on them
51 (for they are your people and your inheritance, which you brought out of Egypt, from the middle of the iron furnace);
52 that your eyes may be open to the supplication of your servant and to the supplication of your people Israel, to listen to them whenever they cry to you.
53 For you separated them from among all the peoples of the earth to be your inheritance, as you spoke by Moses your servant, when you brought our fathers out of Egypt, Lord Yahweh.”
54 It was so, that when Solomon had finished praying all this prayer and supplication to Yahweh, he arose from before Yahweh’s altar, from kneeling on his knees with his hands spread out toward heaven.
55 He stood and blessed all the assembly of Israel with a loud voice, saying,
56 “Blessed be Yahweh, who has given rest to his people Israel, according to all that he promised. There has not failed one word of all his good promise, which he promised by Moses his servant.
57 May Yahweh our God be with us as he was with our fathers. Let him not leave us or forsake us,
58 that he may incline our hearts to him, to walk in all his ways, and to keep his commandments, his statutes, and his ordinances, which he commanded our fathers.
59 Let these my words, with which I have made supplication before Yahweh, be near to Yahweh our God day and night, that he may maintain the cause of his servant and the cause of his people Israel, as every day requires;
60 that all the peoples of the earth may know that Yahweh himself is God. There is no one else.
61 “Let your heart therefore be perfect with Yahweh our God, to walk in his statutes, and to keep his commandments, as it is today.”
62 The king, and all Israel with him, offered sacrifice before Yahweh.
63 Solomon offered for the sacrifice of peace offerings, which he offered to Yahweh, twenty two thousand head of cattle and one hundred twenty thousand sheep. So the king and all the children of Israel dedicated Yahweh’s house.
64 The same day the king made the middle of the court holy that was before Yahweh’s house; for there he offered the burnt offering, the meal offering, and the fat of the peace offerings, because the bronze altar that was before Yahweh was too little to receive the burnt offering, the meal offering, and the fat of the peace offerings.
65 So Solomon held the feast at that time, and all Israel with him, a great assembly, from the entrance of Hamath to the brook of Egypt, before Yahweh our God, seven days and seven more days, even fourteen days.
66 On the eighth day he sent the people away; and they blessed the king, and went to their tents joyful and glad in their hearts for all the goodness that Yahweh had shown to David his servant, and to Israel his people.

9

1 When Solomon had finished the building of Yahweh’s house, the king’s house, and all Solomon’s desire which he was pleased to do,

2 Yahweh appeared to Solomon the
second time, as he had appeared to him at
Gibeon.
3 Yahweh said to him, “I have heard
your prayer and your supplication that
you have made before me. I have made
this house holy, which you have built, to
put my name there forever; and my eyes
and my heart shall be there perpetually.
4 As for you, if you will walk before me
as David your father walked, in integrity
of heart and in uprightness, to do
according to all that I have commanded
you, and will keep my statutes and my
ordinances,
5 then I will establish the throne of your
kingdom over Israel forever, as I
promised to David your father, saying,
‘There shall not fail from you a man on
the throne of Israel.’
6 But if you turn away from following
me, you or your children, and not keep
my commandments and my statutes
which I have set before you, but go and
serve other gods and worship them,
7 then I will cut off Israel out of the land
which I have given them; and I will cast
this house, which I have made holy for my
name, out of my sight; and Israel will be a
proverb and a byword among all peoples.
8 Though this house is so high, yet
everyone who passes by it will be
astonished and hiss; and they will say,
‘Why has Yahweh done this to this land
and to this house?’
9 and they will answer, ‘Because they
abandoned Yahweh their God, who
brought their fathers out of the land of
Egypt, and embraced other gods, and
worshiped them, and served them.
Therefore Yahweh has brought all this
evil on them.’ ”
10 At the end of twenty years, in which
Solomon had built the two houses,
Yahweh’s house and the king’s house
11 (now Hiram the king of Tyre had
furnished Solomon with cedar trees and
cypress trees, and with gold, according to
all his desire), King Solomon gave Hiram
twenty cities in the land of Galilee.
12 Hiram came out of Tyre to see the
cities which Solomon had given him; and
they didn’t please him.
13 He said, “What cities are these which
you have given me, my brother?” He
called them the land of Cabul† to this day.
14 Hiram sent to the king one hundred
twenty talents‡ of gold.
15 This is the reason of the forced labor
which King Solomon conscripted: to build
Yahweh’s house, his own house, Millo,
Jerusalem’s wall, Hazor, Megiddo, and
Gezer.
16 Pharaoh king of Egypt had gone up,
taken Gezer, burned it with fire, killed the
Canaanites who lived in the city, and
given it for a wedding gift to his daughter,
Solomon’s wife.
17 Solomon built in the land Gezer, Beth
Horon the lower,
18 Baalath, Tamar in the wilderness,
19 all the storage cities that Solomon
had, the cities for his chariots, the cities
for his horsemen, and that which
Solomon desired to build for his pleasure
in Jerusalem, and in Lebanon, and in all
the land of his dominion.
20 As for all the people who were left of
the Amorites, the Hittites, the Perizzites,
the Hivites, and the Jebusites, who were
not of the children of Israel—
21 their children who were left after
them in the land, whom the children of
Israel were not able utterly to destroy—of
them Solomon raised a levy of
bondservants to this day.
22 But of the children of Israel Solomon
made no bondservants; but they were the
men of war, his servants, his princes, his
captains, and rulers of his chariots and of
his horsemen.
23 These were the five hundred fifty
chief officers who were over Solomon’s
work, who ruled over the people who
labored in the work.
24 But Pharaoh’s daughter came up out
of David’s city to her house which
Solomon had built for her. Then he built
Millo.

† **9:13** “Cabul” sounds like Hebrew for “good-for-nothing”.
‡ **9:14** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 120 talents is about 3.6 metric tons

25 Solomon offered burnt offerings and
peace offerings on the altar which he built
to Yahweh three times per year, burning
incense with them on the altar that was
before Yahweh. So he finished the house.
26 King Solomon made a fleet of ships in
Ezion Geber, which is beside Eloth, on the
shore of the Red Sea, in the land of Edom.
27 Hiram sent in the fleet his servants,
sailors who had knowledge of the sea,
with the servants of Solomon.
28 They came to Ophir, and fetched from
there gold, four hundred and twenty
talents,§ and brought it to King Solomon.

10

1 When the queen of Sheba heard of the
fame of Solomon concerning Yahweh's
name, she came to test him with hard
questions.
2 She came to Jerusalem with a very
great caravan, with camels that bore
spices, very much gold, and precious
stones; and when she had come to
Solomon, she talked with him about all
that was in her heart.
3 Solomon answered all her questions.
There wasn't anything hidden from the
king which he didn't tell her.
4 When the queen of Sheba had seen all
the wisdom of Solomon, the house that he
had built,
5 the food of his table, the sitting of his
servants, the attendance of his officials,
their clothing, his cup bearers, and his
ascent by which he went up to Yahweh's
house, there was no more spirit in her.
6 She said to the king, "It was a true
report that I heard in my own land of your
acts and of your wisdom.
7 However, I didn't believe the words
until I came and my eyes had seen it.
Behold, not even half was told me! Your
wisdom and prosperity exceed the fame
which I heard.
8 Happy are your men, happy are these
your servants who stand continually
before you, who hear your wisdom.
9 Blessed is Yahweh your God, who
delighted in you, to set you on the throne
of Israel. Because Yahweh loved Israel
forever, therefore he made you king, to do
justice and righteousness."
10 She gave the king one hundred
twenty talents of gold, and a very great
quantity of spices, and precious stones.
Never again was there such an
abundance of spices as these which the
queen of Sheba gave to King Solomon.
11 The fleet of Hiram that brought gold
from Ophir also brought in from Ophir
great quantities of almug trees† and
precious stones.
12 The king made of the almug trees
pillars for Yahweh's house and for the
king's house, harps also and stringed
instruments for the singers; no such
almug trees came or were seen to this day.
13 King Solomon gave to the queen of
Sheba all her desire, whatever she asked,
in addition to that which Solomon gave
her of his royal bounty. So she turned and
went to her own land, she and her
servants.
14 Now the weight of gold that came to
Solomon in one year was six hundred
sixty-six talents‡ of gold,
15 in addition to that which the traders
brought, and the traffic of the merchants,
and of all the kings of the mixed people,
and of the governors of the country.
16 King Solomon made two hundred
bucklers of beaten gold; six hundred
shekels§ of gold went to one buckler.
17 He made three hundred shields of
beaten gold; three minas† of gold went to
one shield; and the king put them in the
House of the Forest of Lebanon.
18 Moreover the king made a great
throne of ivory, and overlaid it with the
finest gold.

§ **9:28** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 420 talents is about 12.6 metric tons † **10:11** possibly an Indian sandalwood, with nice grain and a pleasant scent, and good for woodworking ‡ **10:14** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 666 talents is about 20 metric tons § **10:16** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 600 shekels is about 6 kilograms or 13.2 pounds or 192 Troy ounces. † **10:17** A mina is about 600 grams or 1.3 U. S. pounds.

19 There were six steps to the throne,
and the top of the throne was round
behind; and there were armrests on
either side by the place of the seat, and
two lions standing beside the armrests.
20 Twelve lions stood there on the one
side and on the other on the six steps.
Nothing like it was made in any kingdom.
21 All King Solomon's drinking vessels
were of gold, and all the vessels of the
House of the Forest of Lebanon were of
pure gold. None were of silver, because it
was considered of little value in the days
of Solomon.
22 For the king had a fleet of ships of
Tarshish at sea with Hiram's fleet. Once
every three years the fleet of Tarshish
came bringing gold, silver, ivory, apes,
and peacocks.
23 So King Solomon exceeded all the
kings of the earth in riches and in wisdom.
24 All the earth sought the presence of
Solomon to hear his wisdom which God
had put in his heart.
25 Year after year, every man brought
his tribute, vessels of silver, vessels of
gold, clothing, armor, spices, horses, and
mules.
26 Solomon gathered together chariots
and horsemen. He had one thousand four
hundred chariots and twelve thousand
horsemen. He kept them in the chariot
cities and with the king at Jerusalem.
27 The king made silver as common as
stones in Jerusalem, and cedars as
common as the sycamore trees that are in
the lowland.
28 The horses which Solomon had were
brought out of Egypt. The king's
merchants received them in droves, each
drove at a price.
29 A chariot was imported from Egypt
for six hundred shekels‡ of silver, and a
horse for one hundred fifty shekels; and
so they exported them to all the kings of
the Hittites and to the kings of Syria.

11

1 Now King Solomon loved many
foreign women, together with the
daughter of Pharaoh: women of the
Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites,
Sidonians, and Hittites,
2 of the nations concerning which
Yahweh said to the children of Israel, "You
shall not go among them, neither shall
they come among you, for surely they will
turn away your heart after their gods."
Solomon joined to these in love.
3 He had seven hundred wives,
princesses, and three hundred
concubines. His wives turned his heart
away.
4 When Solomon was old, his wives
turned away his heart after other gods;
and his heart was not perfect with
Yahweh his God, as the heart of David his
father was.
5 For Solomon went after Ashtoreth the
goddess of the Sidonians, and after
Milcom the abomination of the
Ammonites.
6 Solomon did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight, and didn't go fully after
Yahweh, as David his father did.
7 Then Solomon built a high place for
Chemosh the abomination of Moab, on
the mountain that is before Jerusalem,
and for Molech the abomination of the
children of Ammon.
8 So he did for all his foreign wives, who
burned incense and sacrificed to their
gods.
9 Yahweh was angry with Solomon,
because his heart was turned away from
Yahweh, the God of Israel, who had
appeared to him twice,
10 and had commanded him concerning
this thing, that he should not go after
other gods; but he didn't keep that which
Yahweh commanded.
11 Therefore Yahweh said to Solomon,
"Because this is done by you, and you
have not kept my covenant and my
statutes, which I have commanded you, I
will surely tear the kingdom from you,
and will give it to your servant.
12 Nevertheless, I will not do it in your
days, for David your father's sake; but I
will tear it out of your son's hand.
13 However, I will not tear away all the
kingdom; but I will give one tribe to your

‡ **10:29** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

son, for David my servant's sake, and for Jerusalem's sake which I have chosen."
14 Yahweh raised up an adversary to Solomon: Hadad the Edomite. He was one of the king's offspring in Edom.
15 For when David was in Edom, and Joab the captain of the army had gone up to bury the slain, and had struck every male in Edom
16 (for Joab and all Israel remained there six months, until he had cut off every male in Edom),
17 Hadad fled, he and certain Edomites of his father's servants with him, to go into Egypt, when Hadad was still a little child.
18 They arose out of Midian and came to Paran; and they took men with them out of Paran, and they came to Egypt, to Pharaoh king of Egypt, who gave him a house, and appointed him food, and gave him land.
19 Hadad found great favor in the sight of Pharaoh, so that he gave him as wife the sister of his own wife, the sister of Tahpenes the queen.
20 The sister of Tahpenes bore him Genubath his son, whom Tahpenes weaned in Pharaoh's house; and Genubath was in Pharaoh's house among the sons of Pharaoh.
21 When Hadad heard in Egypt that David slept with his fathers, and that Joab the captain of the army was dead, Hadad said to Pharaoh, "Let me depart, that I may go to my own country."
22 Then Pharaoh said to him, "But what have you lacked with me, that behold, you seek to go to your own country?"
He answered, "Nothing, however only let me depart."
23 God raised up an adversary to him, Rezon the son of Eliada, who had fled from his lord, Hadadezer king of Zobah.
24 He gathered men to himself, and became captain over a troop, when David killed them of Zobah. They went to Damascus and lived there, and reigned in Damascus.
25 He was an adversary to Israel all the days of Solomon, in addition to the mischief of Hadad. He abhorred Israel, and reigned over Syria.
26 Jeroboam the son of Nebat, an Ephraimite of Zeredah, a servant of Solomon, whose mother's name was Zeruah, a widow, also lifted up his hand against the king.
27 This was the reason why he lifted up his hand against the king: Solomon built Millo, and repaired the breach of his father David's city.
28 The man Jeroboam was a mighty man of valor; and Solomon saw that the young man was industrious, and he put him in charge of all the labor of the house of Joseph.
29 At that time, when Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, the prophet Ahijah the Shilonite found him on the way. Now Ahijah had clad himself with a new garment; and the two of them were alone in the field.
30 Ahijah took the new garment that was on him, and tore it in twelve pieces.
31 He said to Jeroboam, "Take ten pieces; for Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, 'Behold, I will tear the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon and will give ten tribes to you
32 (but he shall have one tribe, for my servant David's sake and for Jerusalem's sake, the city which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel),
33 because they have forsaken me, and have worshiped Ashtoreth the goddess of the Sidonians, Chemosh the god of Moab, and Milcom the god of the children of Ammon. They have not walked in my ways, to do that which is right in my eyes, and to keep my statutes and my ordinances, as David his father did.
34 " 'However, I will not take the whole kingdom out of his hand, but I will make him prince all the days of his life for David my servant's sake whom I chose, who kept my commandments and my statutes,
35 but I will take the kingdom out of his son's hand and will give it to you, even ten tribes.
36 I will give one tribe to his son, that David my servant may have a lamp always before me in Jerusalem, the city which I have chosen for myself to put my

name there.
37 I will take you, and you shall reign
according to all that your soul desires, and
shall be king over Israel.
38 It shall be, if you will listen to all that I
command you, and will walk in my ways,
and do that which is right in my eyes, to
keep my statutes and my commandments,
as David my servant did, that I will be with
you, and will build you a sure house, as I
built for David, and will give Israel to you.
39 I will afflict the offspring of David for
this, but not forever.' "
40 Therefore Solomon sought to kill
Jeroboam, but Jeroboam arose and fled
into Egypt, to Shishak king of Egypt, and
was in Egypt until the death of Solomon.
41 Now the rest of the acts of Solomon,
and all that he did, and his wisdom, aren't
they written in the book of the acts of
Solomon?
42 The time that Solomon reigned in
Jerusalem over all Israel was forty years.
43 Solomon slept with his fathers, and
was buried in his father David's city; and
Rehoboam his son reigned in his place.

12

1 Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all
Israel had come to Shechem to make him
king.
2 When Jeroboam the son of Nebat
heard of it (for he was yet in Egypt, where
he had fled from the presence of King
Solomon, and Jeroboam lived in Egypt;
3 and they sent and called him),
Jeroboam and all the assembly of Israel
came, and spoke to Rehoboam, saying,
4 "Your father made our yoke difficult.
Now therefore make the hard service of
your father, and his heavy yoke which he
put on us, lighter, and we will serve you."
5 He said to them, "Depart for three
days, then come back to me."
So the people departed.
6 King Rehoboam took counsel with the
old men who had stood before Solomon
his father while he yet lived, saying,
"What counsel do you give me to answer
these people?"
7 They replied, "If you will be a servant
to this people today, and will serve them,
and answer them with good words, then
they will be your servants forever."
8 But he abandoned the counsel of the
old men which they had given him, and
took counsel with the young men who had
grown up with him, who stood before
him.
9 He said to them, "What counsel do you
give, that we may answer these people
who have spoken to me, saying, 'Make the
yoke that your father put on us lighter'?"
10 The young men who had grown up
with him said to him, "Tell these people
who spoke to you, saying, 'Your father
made our yoke heavy, but make it lighter
to us'—tell them, 'My little finger is thicker
than my father's waist.
11 Now my father burdened you with a
heavy yoke, but I will add to your yoke.
My father chastised you with whips, but I
will chastise you with scorpions.' "
12 So Jeroboam and all the people came
to Rehoboam the third day, as the king
asked, saying, "Come to me again the third
day."
13 The king answered the people
roughly, and abandoned the counsel of
the old men which they had given him,
14 and spoke to them according to the
counsel of the young men, saying, "My
father made your yoke heavy, but I will
add to your yoke. My father chastised you
with whips, but I will chastise you with
scorpions."
15 So the king didn't listen to the people;
for it was a thing brought about from
Yahweh, that he might establish his word,
which Yahweh spoke by Ahijah the
Shilonite to Jeroboam the son of Nebat.
16 When all Israel saw that the king
didn't listen to them, the people answered
the king, saying, "What portion have we
in David? We don't have an inheritance in
the son of Jesse. To your tents, Israel! Now
see to your own house, David." So Israel
departed to their tents.
17 But as for the children of Israel who
lived in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam
reigned over them.

18 Then King Rehoboam sent Adoram,
who was over the men subject to forced
labor; and all Israel stoned him to death
with stones. King Rehoboam hurried to
get himself up to his chariot, to flee to
Jerusalem.
19 So Israel rebelled against David's
house to this day.

20 When all Israel heard that Jeroboam
had returned, they sent and called him to
the congregation, and made him king
over all Israel. There was no one who
followed David's house, except for the
tribe of Judah only.

21 When Rehoboam had come to
Jerusalem, he assembled all the house of
Judah and the tribe of Benjamin, a
hundred and eighty thousand chosen
men who were warriors, to fight against
the house of Israel, to bring the kingdom
again to Rehoboam the son of Solomon.
22 But the word of God came to
Shemaiah the man of God, saying,
23 "Speak to Rehoboam the son of
Solomon, king of Judah, and to all the
house of Judah and Benjamin, and to the
rest of the people, saying,
24 'Yahweh says, "You shall not go up or
fight against your brothers, the children
of Israel. Everyone return to his house; for
this thing is from me." ' " So they listened
to Yahweh's word, and returned and went
their way, according to Yahweh's word.

25 Then Jeroboam built Shechem in the
hill country of Ephraim, and lived in it;
and he went out from there and built
Penuel.
26 Jeroboam said in his heart, "Now the
kingdom will return to David's house.
27 If this people goes up to offer
sacrifices in Yahweh's house at Jerusalem,
then the heart of this people will turn
again to their lord, even to Rehoboam
king of Judah; and they will kill me, and
return to Rehoboam king of Judah."
28 So the king took counsel, and made
two calves of gold; and he said to them, "It
is too much for you to go up to Jerusalem.
Look and behold your gods, Israel, which
brought you up out of the land of Egypt!"
29 He set the one in Bethel, and the other
he put in Dan.
30 This thing became a sin, for the
people went even as far as Dan to worship
before the one there.
31 He made houses of high places, and
made priests from among all the people,
who were not of the sons of Levi.
32 Jeroboam ordained a feast in the
eighth month, on the fifteenth day of the
month, like the feast that is in Judah, and
he went up to the altar. He did so in
Bethel, sacrificing to the calves that he had
made, and he placed in Bethel the priests
of the high places that he had made.
33 He went up to the altar which he had
made in Bethel on the fifteenth day in the
eighth month, even in the month which
he had devised of his own heart; and he
ordained a feast for the children of Israel,
and went up to the altar to burn incense.

13

1 Behold, a man of God came out of
Judah by Yahweh's word to Bethel; and
Jeroboam was standing by the altar to
burn incense.
2 He cried against the altar by Yahweh's
word, and said, "Altar! Altar! Yahweh
says: 'Behold, a son will be born to David's
house, Josiah by name. On you he will
sacrifice the priests of the high places who
burn incense on you, and they will burn
men's bones on you.' "
3 He gave a sign the same day, saying,
"This is the sign which Yahweh has
spoken: Behold, the altar will be split
apart, and the ashes that are on it will be
poured out."

4 When the king heard the saying of the
man of God, which he cried against the
altar in Bethel, Jeroboam put out his hand
from the altar, saying, "Seize him!" His
hand, which he put out against him, dried
up, so that he could not draw it back again
to himself.
5 The altar was also split apart, and the
ashes poured out from the altar,
according to the sign which the man of
God had given by Yahweh's word.

6 The king answered the man of God,
“Now intercede for the favor of Yahweh
your God, and pray for me, that my hand
may be restored to me.”
The man of God interceded with
Yahweh, and the king’s hand was restored
to him, and became as it was before.
7 The king said to the man of God,
“Come home with me and refresh
yourself, and I will give you a reward.”
8 The man of God said to the king, “Even
if you gave me half of your house, I would
not go in with you, neither would I eat
bread nor drink water in this place;
9 for so was it commanded me by
Yahweh’s word, saying, ‘You shall eat no
bread, drink no water, and don’t return
by the way that you came.’ ”
10 So he went another way, and didn’t
return by the way that he came to Bethel.
11 Now an old prophet lived in Bethel,
and one of his sons came and told him all
the works that the man of God had done
that day in Bethel. They also told their
father the words which he had spoken to
the king.
12 Their father said to them, “Which
way did he go?” Now his sons had seen
which way the man of God went, who
came from Judah.
13 He said to his sons, “Saddle the
donkey for me.” So they saddled the
donkey for him; and he rode on it.
14 He went after the man of God, and
found him sitting under an oak. He said to
him, “Are you the man of God who came
from Judah?”
He said, “I am.”
15 Then he said to him, “Come home
with me and eat bread.”
16 He said, “I may not return with you,
nor go in with you. I will not eat bread or
drink water with you in this place.
17 For it was said to me by Yahweh’s
word, ‘You shall eat no bread or drink
water there, and don’t turn again to go by
the way that you came.’ ”
18 He said to him, “I also am a prophet as
you are; and an angel spoke to me by
Yahweh’s word, saying, ‘Bring him back
with you into your house, that he may eat
bread and drink water.’ ” He lied to him.
19 So he went back with him, ate bread
in his house, and drank water.
20 As they sat at the table, Yahweh’s
word came to the prophet who brought
him back;
21 and he cried out to the man of God
who came from Judah, saying, “Yahweh
says, ‘Because you have been disobedient
to Yahweh’s word, and have not kept the
commandment which Yahweh your God
commanded you,
22 but came back, and have eaten bread
and drank water in the place of which he
said to you, “Eat no bread, and drink no
water,” your body will not come to the
tomb of your fathers.’ ”
23 After he had eaten bread and after he
drank, he saddled the donkey for the
prophet whom he had brought back.
24 When he had gone, a lion met him by
the way and killed him. His body was
thrown on the path, and the donkey stood
by it. The lion also stood by the body.
25 Behold, men passed by and saw the
body thrown on the path, and the lion
standing by the body; and they came and
told it in the city where the old prophet
lived.
26 When the prophet who brought him
back from the way heard of it, he said, “It
is the man of God who was disobedient to
Yahweh’s word. Therefore Yahweh has
delivered him to the lion, which has
mauled him and slain him, according to
Yahweh’s word which he spoke to him.”
27 He said to his sons, saying, “Saddle
the donkey for me,” and they saddled it.
28 He went and found his body thrown
on the path, and the donkey and the lion
standing by the body. The lion had not
eaten the body nor mauled the donkey.
29 The prophet took up the body of the
man of God, and laid it on the donkey, and
brought it back. He came to the city of the
old prophet to mourn, and to bury him.
30 He laid his body in his own grave; and
they mourned over him, saying, “Alas, my
brother!”
31 After he had buried him, he spoke to
his sons, saying, “When I am dead, bury
me in the tomb in which the man of God is
buried. Lay my bones beside his bones.

32 For the saying which he cried by
Yahweh's word against the altar in Bethel,
and against all the houses of the high
places which are in the cities of Samaria,
will surely happen."
33 After this thing, Jeroboam didn't turn
from his evil way, but again made priests
of the high places from among all the
people. Whoever wanted to, he
consecrated him, that there might be
priests of the high places.
34 This thing became sin to the house of
Jeroboam, even to cut it off and to destroy
it from off the surface of the earth.

14

1 At that time Abijah the son of
Jeroboam became sick.
2 Jeroboam said to his wife, "Please get
up and disguise yourself, so that you
won't be recognized as Jeroboam's wife.
Go to Shiloh. Behold, Ahijah the prophet is
there, who said that I would be king over
this people.
3 Take with you ten loaves of bread,
some cakes, and a jar of honey, and go to
him. He will tell you what will become of
the child."
4 Jeroboam's wife did so, and arose and
went to Shiloh, and came to Ahijah's
house. Now Ahijah could not see, for his
eyes were set by reason of his age.
5 Yahweh said to Ahijah, "Behold,
Jeroboam's wife is coming to inquire of
you concerning her son, for he is sick. Tell
her such and such; for it will be, when she
comes in, that she will pretend to be
another woman."
6 So when Ahijah heard the sound of her
feet as she came in at the door, he said,
"Come in, Jeroboam's wife! Why do you
pretend to be another? For I am sent to
you with heavy news.
7 Go, tell Jeroboam, 'Yahweh, the God of
Israel, says: "Because I exalted you from
among the people, and made you prince
over my people Israel,
8 and tore the kingdom away from
David's house, and gave it to you; and yet
you have not been as my servant David,
who kept my commandments, and who
followed me with all his heart, to do that
only which was right in my eyes,
9 but have done evil above all who were
before you, and have gone and made for
yourself other gods, molten images, to
provoke me to anger, and have cast me
behind your back,
10 therefore, behold, I will bring evil on
the house of Jeroboam, and will cut off
from Jeroboam everyone who urinates on
a wall,† he who is shut up and he who is
left at large in Israel, and will utterly
sweep away the house of Jeroboam, as a
man sweeps away dung until it is all gone.
11 The dogs will eat whoever belongs to
Jeroboam who dies in the city; and the
birds of the sky will eat whoever dies in
the field, for Yahweh has spoken it." '
12 Arise therefore, and go to your house.
When your feet enter into the city, the
child will die.
13 All Israel will mourn for him and bury
him; for he only of Jeroboam will come to
the grave, because in him there is found
some good thing toward Yahweh, the God
of Israel, in the house of Jeroboam.
14 Moreover Yahweh will raise up a king
for himself over Israel who will cut off the
house of Jeroboam. This is the day! What?
Even now.
15 For Yahweh will strike Israel, as a
reed is shaken in the water; and he will
root up Israel out of this good land which
he gave to their fathers, and will scatter
them beyond the River,‡ because they
have made their Asherah poles,
provoking Yahweh to anger.
16 He will give Israel up because of the
sins of Jeroboam, which he has sinned,
and with which he has made Israel to sin."
17 Jeroboam's wife arose and departed,
and came to Tirzah. As she came to the
threshold of the house, the child died.
18 All Israel buried him and mourned
for him, according to Yahweh's word,
which he spoke by his servant Ahijah the
prophet.

19 The rest of the acts of Jeroboam, how
he fought and how he reigned, behold,

† **14:10** or, male ‡ **14:15** That is, the Euphrates.

they are written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel.
20 The days which Jeroboam reigned were twenty two years; then he slept with his fathers, and Nadab his son reigned in his place.
21 Rehoboam the son of Solomon reigned in Judah. Rehoboam was forty-one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city which Yahweh had chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, to put his name there. His mother's name was Naamah the Ammonitess.
22 Judah did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, and they provoked him to jealousy with their sins which they committed, above all that their fathers had done.
23 For they also built for themselves high places, sacred pillars, and Asherah poles on every high hill and under every green tree.
24 There were also sodomites in the land. They did according to all the abominations of the nations which Yahweh drove out before the children of Israel.
25 In the fifth year of King Rehoboam, Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem;
26 and he took away the treasures of Yahweh's house and the treasures of the king's house. He even took away all of it, including all the gold shields which Solomon had made.
27 King Rehoboam made shields of bronze in their place, and committed them to the hands of the captains of the guard, who guarded the door of the king's house.
28 It was so, that as often as the king went into Yahweh's house, the guard bore them, and brought them back into the guard room.
29 Now the rest of the acts of Rehoboam, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?
30 There was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam continually.
31 Rehoboam slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in David's city. His mother's name was Naamah the Ammonitess. Abijam his son reigned in his place.

15

1 Now in the eighteenth year of King Jeroboam the son of Nebat, Abijam began to reign over Judah.
2 He reigned three years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Maacah the daughter of Abishalom.
3 He walked in all the sins of his father, which he had done before him; and his heart was not perfect with Yahweh his God, as the heart of David his father.
4 Nevertheless for David's sake, Yahweh his God gave him a lamp in Jerusalem, to set up his son after him and to establish Jerusalem;
5 because David did that which was right in Yahweh's eyes, and didn't turn away from anything that he commanded him all the days of his life, except only in the matter of Uriah the Hittite.
6 Now there was war between Rehoboam and Jeroboam all the days of his life.
7 The rest of the acts of Abijam, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah? There was war between Abijam and Jeroboam.
8 Abijam slept with his fathers, and they buried him in David's city; and Asa his son reigned in his place.

9 In the twentieth year of Jeroboam king of Israel, Asa began to reign over Judah.
10 He reigned forty-one years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Maacah the daughter of Abishalom.
11 Asa did that which was right in Yahweh's eyes, as David his father did.
12 He put away the sodomites out of the land, and removed all the idols that his fathers had made.
13 He also removed Maacah his mother from being queen, because she had made an abominable image for an Asherah. Asa cut down her image and burned it at the brook Kidron.

14 But the high places were not taken
away. Nevertheless the heart of Asa was
perfect with Yahweh all his days.
15 He brought into Yahweh's house the
things that his father had dedicated, and
the things that he himself had dedicated:
silver, gold, and utensils.

16 There was war between Asa and
Baasha king of Israel all their days.
17 Baasha king of Israel went up against
Judah, and built Ramah, that he might not
allow anyone to go out or come in to Asa
king of Judah.
18 Then Asa took all the silver and the
gold that was left in the treasures of
Yahweh's house, and the treasures of the
king's house, and delivered it into the
hand of his servants. Then King Asa sent
them to Ben Hadad, the son of
Tabrimmon, the son of Hezion, king of
Syria, who lived at Damascus, saying,
19 "Let there be a treaty between me and
you, like that between my father and your
father. Behold, I have sent to you a
present of silver and gold. Go, break your
treaty with Baasha king of Israel, that he
may depart from me."

20 Ben Hadad listened to King Asa, and
sent the captains of his armies against the
cities of Israel, and struck Ijon, and Dan,
and Abel Beth Maacah, and all
Chinneroth, with all the land of Naphtali.
21 When Baasha heard of it, he stopped
building Ramah, and lived in Tirzah.
22 Then King Asa made a proclamation
to all Judah. No one was exempted. They
carried away the stones of Ramah, and its
timber, with which Baasha had built; and
King Asa used it to build Geba of
Benjamin, and Mizpah.
23 Now the rest of all the acts of Asa, and
all his might, and all that he did, and the
cities which he built, aren't they written
in the book of the chronicles of the kings
of Judah? But in the time of his old age he
was diseased in his feet.
24 Asa slept with his fathers, and was
buried with his fathers in his father
David's city; and Jehoshaphat his son
reigned in his place.

25 Nadab the son of Jeroboam began to
reign over Israel in the second year of Asa
king of Judah; and he reigned over Israel
two years.
26 He did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight, and walked in the way of
his father, and in his sin with which he
made Israel to sin.
27 Baasha the son of Ahijah, of the house
of Issachar, conspired against him; and
Baasha struck him at Gibbethon, which
belonged to the Philistines; for Nadab and
all Israel were besieging Gibbethon.
28 Even in the third year of Asa king of
Judah, Baasha killed him and reigned in
his place.
29 As soon as he was king, he struck all
the house of Jeroboam. He didn't leave to
Jeroboam any who breathed, until he had
destroyed him, according to the saying of
Yahweh, which he spoke by his servant
Ahijah the Shilonite;
30 for the sins of Jeroboam which he
sinned, and with which he made Israel to
sin, because of his provocation with
which he provoked Yahweh, the God of
Israel, to anger.

31 Now the rest of the acts of Nadab, and
all that he did, aren't they written in the
book of the chronicles of the kings of
Israel?
32 There was war between Asa and
Baasha king of Israel all their days.

33 In the third year of Asa king of Judah,
Baasha the son of Ahijah began to reign
over all Israel in Tirzah for twenty-four
years.
34 He did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight, and walked in the way of
Jeroboam, and in his sin with which he
made Israel to sin.

16

1 Yahweh's word came to Jehu the son of
Hanani against Baasha, saying,
2 "Because I exalted you out of the dust
and made you prince over my people
Israel, and you have walked in the way of
Jeroboam and have made my people
Israel to sin, to provoke me to anger with
their sins,

3 behold, I will utterly sweep away
Baasha and his house; and I will make
your house like the house of Jeroboam the
son of Nebat.
4 The dogs will eat Baasha's descendants
who die in the city; and he who dies of his
in the field, the birds of the sky will eat."
5 Now the rest of the acts of Baasha, and
what he did, and his might, aren't they
written in the book of the chronicles of
the kings of Israel?
6 Baasha slept with his fathers, and was
buried in Tirzah; and Elah his son reigned
in his place.
7 Moreover Yahweh's word came by the
prophet Jehu the son of Hanani against
Baasha and against his house, both
because of all the evil that he did in
Yahweh's sight, to provoke him to anger
with the work of his hands, in being like
the house of Jeroboam, and because he
struck him.
8 In the twenty-sixth year of Asa king of
Judah, Elah the son of Baasha began to
reign over Israel in Tirzah for two years.
9 His servant Zimri, captain of half his
chariots, conspired against him. Now he
was in Tirzah, drinking himself drunk in
the house of Arza, who was over the
household in Tirzah;
10 and Zimri went in and struck him and
killed him in the twenty-seventh year of
Asa king of Judah, and reigned in his
place.
11 When he began to reign, as soon as he
sat on his throne, he attacked all the house
of Baasha. He didn't leave him a single
one who urinates on a wall† among his
relatives or his friends.
12 Thus Zimri destroyed all the house of
Baasha, according to Yahweh's word
which he spoke against Baasha by Jehu
the prophet,
13 for all the sins of Baasha, and the sins
of Elah his son, which they sinned and
with which they made Israel to sin, to
provoke Yahweh, the God of Israel, to
anger with their vanities.
14 Now the rest of the acts of Elah, and
all that he did, aren't they written in the
book of the chronicles of the kings of
Israel?
15 In the twenty-seventh year of Asa
king of Judah, Zimri reigned seven days in
Tirzah. Now the people were encamped
against Gibbethon, which belonged to the
Philistines.
16 The people who were encamped
heard that Zimri had conspired, and had
also killed the king. Therefore all Israel
made Omri, the captain of the army, king
over Israel that day in the camp.
17 Omri went up from Gibbethon, and
all Israel with him, and they besieged
Tirzah.
18 When Zimri saw that the city was
taken, he went into the fortified part of
the king's house and burned the king's
house over him with fire, and died,
19 for his sins which he sinned in doing
that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, in
walking in the way of Jeroboam, and in
his sin which he did to make Israel to sin.
20 Now the rest of the acts of Zimri, and
his treason that he committed, aren't they
written in the book of the chronicles of
the kings of Israel?
21 Then the people of Israel were
divided into two parts: half of the people
followed Tibni the son of Ginath, to make
him king, and half followed Omri.
22 But the people who followed Omri
prevailed against the people who
followed Tibni the son of Ginath; so Tibni
died, and Omri reigned.
23 In the thirty-first year of Asa king of
Judah, Omri began to reign over Israel for
twelve years. He reigned six years in
Tirzah.
24 He bought the hill Samaria of Shemer
for two talents‡ of silver; and he built on
the hill, and called the name of the city
which he built, Samaria, after the name of
Shemer, the owner of the hill.
25 Omri did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight, and dealt wickedly above
all who were before him.
26 For he walked in all the way of
Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and in his sins
with which he made Israel to sin, to

† **16:11** or, male ‡ **16:24** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds.

provoke Yahweh, the God of Israel, to anger with their vanities.
27 Now the rest of the acts of Omri which he did, and his might that he showed, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?
28 So Omri slept with his fathers, and was buried in Samaria; and Ahab his son reigned in his place.

29 In the thirty-eighth year of Asa king of Judah, Ahab the son of Omri began to reign over Israel. Ahab the son of Omri reigned over Israel in Samaria twenty-two years.
30 Ahab the son of Omri did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight above all that were before him.
31 As if it had been a light thing for him to walk in the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, he took as wife Jezebel the daughter of Ethbaal king of the Sidonians, and went and served Baal and worshiped him.
32 He raised up an altar for Baal in the house of Baal, which he had built in Samaria.
33 Ahab made the Asherah; and Ahab did more yet to provoke Yahweh, the God of Israel, to anger than all the kings of Israel who were before him.
34 In his days Hiel the Bethelite built Jericho. He laid its foundation with the loss of Abiram his firstborn, and set up its gates with the loss of his youngest son Segub, according to Yahweh's word, which he spoke by Joshua the son of Nun.

17

1 Elijah the Tishbite, who was one of the settlers of Gilead, said to Ahab, "As Yahweh, the God of Israel, lives, before whom I stand, there shall not be dew nor rain these years, but according to my word."
2 Then Yahweh's word came to him, saying,
3 "Go away from here, turn eastward, and hide yourself by the brook Cherith, that is before the Jordan.
4 You shall drink from the brook. I have commanded the ravens to feed you there."
5 So he went and did according to Yahweh's word, for he went and lived by the brook Cherith that is before the Jordan.
6 The ravens brought him bread and meat in the morning, and bread and meat in the evening; and he drank from the brook.
7 After a while, the brook dried up, because there was no rain in the land.
8 Yahweh's word came to him, saying,
9 "Arise, go to Zarephath, which belongs to Sidon, and stay there. Behold, I have commanded a widow there to sustain you."
10 So he arose and went to Zarephath; and when he came to the gate of the city, behold, a widow was there gathering sticks. He called to her and said, "Please get me a little water in a jar, that I may drink."
11 As she was going to get it, he called to her and said, "Please bring me a morsel of bread in your hand."
12 She said, "As Yahweh your God lives, I don't have anything baked, but only a handful of meal in a jar and a little oil in a jar. Behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and bake it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die."
13 Elijah said to her, "Don't be afraid. Go and do as you have said; but make me a little cake from it first, and bring it out to me, and afterward make some for you and for your son.
14 For Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, 'The jar of meal will not run out, and the jar of oil will not fail, until the day that Yahweh sends rain on the earth.' "
15 She went and did according to the saying of Elijah; and she, he, and her household ate many days.
16 The jar of meal didn't run out and the jar of oil didn't fail, according to Yahweh's word, which he spoke by Elijah.
17 After these things, the son of the woman, the mistress of the house, became sick; and his sickness was so severe that there was no breath left in him.
18 She said to Elijah, "What have I to do with you, you man of God? You have come

to me to bring my sin to memory, and to kill my son!"
19 He said to her, "Give me your son." He took him out of her bosom, and carried him up into the room where he stayed, and laid him on his own bed.
20 He cried to Yahweh and said, "Yahweh my God, have you also brought evil on the widow with whom I am staying, by killing her son?"
21 He stretched himself on the child three times, and cried to Yahweh and said, "Yahweh my God, please let this child's soul come into him again."
22 Yahweh listened to the voice of Elijah; and the soul of the child came into him again, and he revived.
23 Elijah took the child and brought him down out of the room into the house, and delivered him to his mother; and Elijah said, "Behold, your son lives."
24 The woman said to Elijah, "Now I know that you are a man of God, and that Yahweh's word in your mouth is truth."

18

1 After many days, Yahweh's word came to Elijah, in the third year, saying, "Go, show yourself to Ahab; and I will send rain on the earth."
2 Elijah went to show himself to Ahab. The famine was severe in Samaria.
3 Ahab called Obadiah, who was over the household. (Now Obadiah feared Yahweh greatly;
4 for when Jezebel cut off Yahweh's prophets, Obadiah took one hundred prophets, and hid them fifty to a cave, and fed them with bread and water.)
5 Ahab said to Obadiah, "Go through the land, to all the springs of water, and to all the brooks. Perhaps we may find grass and save the horses and mules alive, that we not lose all the animals."
6 So they divided the land between them to pass throughout it. Ahab went one way by himself, and Obadiah went another way by himself.
7 As Obadiah was on the way, behold, Elijah met him. He recognized him, and fell on his face, and said, "Is it you, my lord Elijah?"
8 He answered him, "It is I. Go, tell your lord, 'Behold, Elijah is here!' "
9 He said, "How have I sinned, that you would deliver your servant into the hand of Ahab, to kill me?
10 As Yahweh your God lives, there is no nation or kingdom where my lord has not sent to seek you. When they said, 'He is not here,' he took an oath of the kingdom and nation that they didn't find you.
11 Now you say, 'Go, tell your lord, "Behold, Elijah is here." '
12 It will happen, as soon as I leave you, that Yahweh's Spirit will carry you I don't know where; and so when I come and tell Ahab, and he can't find you, he will kill me. But I, your servant, have feared Yahweh from my youth.
13 Wasn't it told my lord what I did when Jezebel killed Yahweh's prophets, how I hid one hundred men of Yahweh's prophets with fifty to a cave, and fed them with bread and water?
14 Now you say, 'Go, tell your lord, "Behold, Elijah is here".' He will kill me."
15 Elijah said, "As Yahweh of Armies lives, before whom I stand, I will surely show myself to him today."
16 So Obadiah went to meet Ahab, and told him; and Ahab went to meet Elijah.
17 When Ahab saw Elijah, Ahab said to him, "Is that you, you troubler of Israel?"
18 He answered, "I have not troubled Israel, but you and your father's house, in that you have forsaken Yahweh's commandments and you have followed the Baals.
19 Now therefore send, and gather to me all Israel to Mount Carmel, and four hundred fifty of the prophets of Baal, and four hundred of the prophets of the Asherah, who eat at Jezebel's table."
20 So Ahab sent to all the children of Israel, and gathered the prophets together to Mount Carmel.
21 Elijah came near to all the people, and said, "How long will you waver between the two sides? If Yahweh is God, follow him; but if Baal, then follow him."
The people didn't say a word.

22 Then Elijah said to the people, “I, even
I only, am left as a prophet of Yahweh; but
Baal’s prophets are four hundred fifty
men.
23 Let them therefore give us two bulls;
and let them choose one bull for
themselves, and cut it in pieces, and lay it
on the wood, and put no fire under; and I
will dress the other bull, and lay it on the
wood, and put no fire under it.
24 You call on the name of your god, and
I will call on Yahweh’s name. The God
who answers by fire, let him be God.”
All the people answered, “What you say
is good.”
25 Elijah said to the prophets of Baal,
“Choose one bull for yourselves, and dress
it first, for you are many; and call on the
name of your god, but put no fire under
it.”
26 They took the bull which was given
them, and they dressed it, and called on
the name of Baal from morning even until
noon, saying, “Baal, hear us!” But there
was no voice, and nobody answered. They
leaped about the altar which was made.
27 At noon, Elijah mocked them, and
said, “Cry aloud, for he is a god. Either he
is deep in thought, or he has gone
somewhere, or he is on a journey, or
perhaps he sleeps and must be
awakened.”
28 They cried aloud, and cut themselves
in their way with knives and lances until
the blood gushed out on them.
29 When midday was past, they
prophesied until the time of the evening
offering; but there was no voice, no
answer, and nobody paid attention.
30 Elijah said to all the people, “Come
near to me!”; and all the people came near
to him. He repaired Yahweh’s altar that
had been thrown down.
31 Elijah took twelve stones, according
to the number of the tribes of the sons of
Jacob, to whom Yahweh’s word came,
saying, “Israel shall be your name.”
32 With the stones he built an altar in
Yahweh’s name. He made a trench
around the altar large enough to contain
two seahs† of seed.
33 He put the wood in order, and cut the
bull in pieces and laid it on the wood. He
said, “Fill four jars with water, and pour it
on the burnt offering and on the wood.”
34 He said, “Do it a second time;” and
they did it the second time. He said, “Do it
a third time;” and they did it the third
time.
35 The water ran around the altar; and
he also filled the trench with water.
36 At the time of the evening offering,
Elijah the prophet came near and said,
“Yahweh, the God of Abraham, of Isaac,
and of Israel, let it be known today that
you are God in Israel and that I am your
servant, and that I have done all these
things at your word.
37 Hear me, Yahweh, hear me, that this
people may know that you, Yahweh, are
God, and that you have turned their heart
back again.”
38 Then Yahweh’s fire fell and consumed
the burnt offering, the wood, the stones,
and the dust; and it licked up the water
that was in the trench.
39 When all the people saw it, they fell
on their faces. They said, “Yahweh, he is
God! Yahweh, he is God!”
40 Elijah said to them, “Seize the
prophets of Baal! Don’t let one of them
escape!”
They seized them; and Elijah brought
them down to the brook Kishon, and
killed them there.
41 Elijah said to Ahab, “Get up, eat and
drink; for there is the sound of abundance
of rain.”
42 So Ahab went up to eat and to drink.
Elijah went up to the top of Carmel; and
he bowed himself down on the earth, and
put his face between his knees.
43 He said to his servant, “Go up now
and look toward the sea.”
He went up and looked, then said,
“There is nothing.”
He said, “Go again” seven times.
44 On the seventh time, he said, “Behold,
a small cloud, like a man’s hand, is rising
out of the sea.”

† **18:32** 1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks

He said, “Go up, tell Ahab, ‘Get ready and go down, so that the rain doesn’t stop you.’ ”
45 In a little while, the sky grew black with clouds and wind, and there was a great rain. Ahab rode, and went to Jezreel.
46 Yahweh’s hand was on Elijah; and he tucked his cloak into his belt and ran before Ahab to the entrance of Jezreel.

19

1 Ahab told Jezebel all that Elijah had done, and how he had killed all the prophets with the sword.
2 Then Jezebel sent a messenger to Elijah, saying, “So let the gods do to me, and more also, if I don’t make your life as the life of one of them by tomorrow about this time!”
3 When he saw that, he arose and ran for his life, and came to Beersheba, which belongs to Judah, and left his servant there.
4 But he himself went a day’s journey into the wilderness, and came and sat down under a juniper tree. Then he requested for himself that he might die, and said, “It is enough. Now, O Yahweh, take away my life; for I am not better than my fathers.”
5 He lay down and slept under a juniper tree; and behold, an angel touched him, and said to him, “Arise and eat!”
6 He looked, and behold, there was at his head a cake baked on the coals, and a jar of water. He ate and drank, and lay down again.
7 Yahweh’s angel came again the second time, and touched him, and said, “Arise and eat, because the journey is too great for you.”
8 He arose, and ate and drank, and went in the strength of that food forty days and forty nights to Horeb, God’s Mountain.
9 He came to a cave there, and camped there; and behold, Yahweh’s word came to him, and he said to him, “What are you doing here, Elijah?”
10 He said, “I have been very jealous for Yahweh, the God of Armies; for the children of Israel have forsaken your covenant, thrown down your altars, and killed your prophets with the sword. I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.”
11 He said, “Go out and stand on the mountain before Yahweh.”
Behold, Yahweh passed by, and a great and strong wind tore the mountains and broke in pieces the rocks before Yahweh; but Yahweh was not in the wind. After the wind there was an earthquake; but Yahweh was not in the earthquake.
12 After the earthquake a fire passed; but Yahweh was not in the fire. After the fire, there was a still small voice.
13 When Elijah heard it, he wrapped his face in his mantle, went out, and stood in the entrance of the cave. Behold, a voice came to him, and said, “What are you doing here, Elijah?”
14 He said, “I have been very jealous for Yahweh, the God of Armies; for the children of Israel have forsaken your covenant, thrown down your altars, and killed your prophets with the sword. I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.”
15 Yahweh said to him, “Go, return on your way to the wilderness of Damascus. When you arrive, anoint Hazael to be king over Syria.
16 Anoint Jehu the son of Nimshi to be king over Israel; and anoint Elisha the son of Shaphat of Abel Meholah to be prophet in your place.
17 He who escapes from the sword of Hazael, Jehu will kill; and he who escapes from the sword of Jehu, Elisha will kill.
18 Yet I reserved seven thousand in Israel, all the knees of which have not bowed to Baal, and every mouth that has not kissed him.”
19 So he departed from there and found Elisha the son of Shaphat, who was plowing with twelve yoke of oxen before him, and he with the twelfth. Elijah went over to him and put his mantle on him.
20 Elisha left the oxen and ran after Elijah, and said, “Let me please kiss my father and my mother, and then I will follow you.”
He said to him, “Go back again; for what have I done to you?”

21 He returned from following him, and took the yoke of oxen, killed them, and boiled their meat with the oxen's equipment, and gave to the people; and they ate. Then he arose, and went after Elijah, and served him.

20

1 Ben Hadad the king of Syria gathered all his army together; and there were thirty-two kings with him, with horses and chariots. He went up and besieged Samaria, and fought against it.
2 He sent messengers into the city to Ahab king of Israel and said to him, "Ben Hadad says,
3 'Your silver and your gold are mine. Your wives also and your children, even the best, are mine.' "
4 The king of Israel answered, "It is according to your saying, my lord, O king. I am yours, and all that I have."
5 The messengers came again and said, "Ben Hadad says, 'I sent indeed to you, saying, "You shall deliver me your silver, your gold, your wives, and your children;
6 but I will send my servants to you tomorrow about this time, and they will search your house and the houses of your servants. Whatever is pleasant in your eyes, they will put it in their hand, and take it away." ' "
7 Then the king of Israel called all the elders of the land, and said, "Please notice how this man seeks mischief; for he sent to me for my wives, and for my children, and for my silver, and for my gold; and I didn't deny him."
8 All the elders and all the people said to him, "Don't listen, and don't consent."
9 Therefore he said to the messengers of Ben Hadad, "Tell my lord the king, 'All that you sent for to your servant at the first I will do, but this thing I cannot do.' "

The messengers departed and brought him back the message.
10 Ben Hadad sent to him, and said, "The gods do so to me, and more also, if the dust of Samaria will be enough for handfuls for all the people who follow me."
11 The king of Israel answered, "Tell him, 'Don't let him who puts on his armor brag like he who takes it off.' "
12 When Ben Hadad heard this message as he was drinking, he and the kings in the pavilions, he said to his servants, "Prepare to attack!" So they prepared to attack the city.
13 Behold, a prophet came near to Ahab king of Israel, and said, "Yahweh says, 'Have you seen all this great multitude? Behold, I will deliver it into your hand today. Then you will know that I am Yahweh.' "
14 Ahab said, "By whom?"

He said, "Yahweh says, 'By the young men of the princes of the provinces.' "

Then he said, "Who shall begin the battle?"

He answered, "You."
15 Then he mustered the young men of the princes of the provinces, and they were two hundred and thirty-two. After them, he mustered all the people, even all the children of Israel, being seven thousand.
16 They went out at noon. But Ben Hadad was drinking himself drunk in the pavilions, he and the kings, the thirty-two kings who helped him.
17 The young men of the princes of the provinces went out first; and Ben Hadad sent out, and they told him, saying, "Men are coming out from Samaria."
18 He said, "If they have come out for peace, take them alive; or if they have come out for war, take them alive."
19 So these went out of the city, the young men of the princes of the provinces, and the army which followed them.
20 They each killed his man. The Syrians fled, and Israel pursued them. Ben Hadad the king of Syria escaped on a horse with horsemen.
21 The king of Israel went out and struck the horses and chariots, and killed the Syrians with a great slaughter.
22 The prophet came near to the king of Israel and said to him, "Go, strengthen yourself, and plan what you must do, for

at the return of the year, the king of Syria will come up against you."

23 The servants of the king of Syria said to him, "Their god is a god of the hills; therefore they were stronger than we. But let's fight against them in the plain, and surely we will be stronger than they.

24 Do this thing: take the kings away, every man out of his place, and put captains in their place.

25 Muster an army like the army that you have lost, horse for horse and chariot for chariot. We will fight against them in the plain, and surely we will be stronger than they are."

He listened to their voice and did so.

26 At the return of the year, Ben Hadad mustered the Syrians and went up to Aphek to fight against Israel.

27 The children of Israel were mustered and given provisions, and went against them. The children of Israel encamped before them like two little flocks of young goats, but the Syrians filled the country.

28 A man of God came near and spoke to the king of Israel, and said, "Yahweh says, 'Because the Syrians have said, "Yahweh is a god of the hills, but he is not a god of the valleys," therefore I will deliver all this great multitude into your hand, and you shall know that I am Yahweh.' "

29 They encamped opposite each other for seven days. Then on the seventh day the battle was joined; and the children of Israel killed one hundred thousand footmen of the Syrians in one day.

30 But the rest fled to Aphek, into the city; and the wall fell on twenty-seven thousand men who were left. Ben Hadad fled and came into the city, into an inner room.

31 His servants said to him, "See now, we have heard that the kings of the house of Israel are merciful kings. Please let us put sackcloth on our bodies and ropes on our heads, and go out to the king of Israel. Maybe he will save your life."

32 So they put sackcloth on their bodies and ropes on their heads, and came to the king of Israel, and said, "Your servant Ben Hadad says, 'Please let me live.' "

He said, "Is he still alive? He is my brother."

33 Now the men observed diligently and hurried to take this phrase; and they said, "Your brother Ben Hadad."

Then he said, "Go, bring him."

Then Ben Hadad came out to him; and he caused him to come up into the chariot.

34 Ben Hadad said to him, "The cities which my father took from your father I will restore. You shall make streets for yourself in Damascus, as my father made in Samaria."

"I", said Ahab, "will let you go with this covenant." So he made a covenant with him and let him go.

35 A certain man of the sons of the prophets said to his fellow by Yahweh's word, "Please strike me!"

The man refused to strike him.

36 Then he said to him, "Because you have not obeyed Yahweh's voice, behold, as soon as you have departed from me, a lion will kill you." As soon as he had departed from him, a lion found him and killed him.

37 Then he found another man, and said, "Please strike me."

The man struck him and wounded him.

38 So the prophet departed and waited for the king by the way, and disguised himself with his headband over his eyes.

39 As the king passed by, he cried to the king, and he said, "Your servant went out into the middle of the battle; and behold, a man came over and brought a man to me, and said, 'Guard this man! If by any means he is missing, then your life shall be for his life, or else you shall pay a talent† of silver.'

40 As your servant was busy here and there, he was gone."

The king of Israel said to him, "So shall your judgment be. You yourself have decided it."

41 He hurried, and took the headband away from his eyes; and the king of Israel recognized that he was one of the prophets.

† **20:39** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

42 He said to him, “Yahweh says,
‘Because you have let go out of your hand
the man whom I had devoted to
destruction, therefore your life will take
the place of his life, and your people take
the place of his people.’ ”

43 The king of Israel went to his house
sullen and angry, and came to Samaria.

21

1 After these things, Naboth the
Jezreelite had a vineyard which was in
Jezreel, next to the palace of Ahab king of
Samaria.
2 Ahab spoke to Naboth, saying, “Give
me your vineyard, that I may have it for a
garden of herbs, because it is near my
house; and I will give you for it a better
vineyard than it. Or, if it seems good to
you, I will give you its worth in money.”

3 Naboth said to Ahab, “May Yahweh
forbid me, that I should give the
inheritance of my fathers to you!”

4 Ahab came into his house sullen and
angry because of the word which Naboth
the Jezreelite had spoken to him, for he
had said, “I will not give you the
inheritance of my fathers.” He laid
himself down on his bed, and turned
away his face, and would eat no bread.
5 But Jezebel his wife came to him, and
said to him, “Why is your spirit so sad that
you eat no bread?”

6 He said to her, “Because I spoke to
Naboth the Jezreelite, and said to him,
‘Give me your vineyard for money; or
else, if it pleases you, I will give you
another vineyard for it.’ He answered, ‘I
will not give you my vineyard.’ ”

7 Jezebel his wife said to him, “Do you
now govern the kingdom of Israel? Arise,
and eat bread, and let your heart be
merry. I will give you the vineyard of
Naboth the Jezreelite.”
8 So she wrote letters in Ahab’s name
and sealed them with his seal, and sent the
letters to the elders and to the nobles who
were in his city, who lived with Naboth.
9 She wrote in the letters, saying,
“Proclaim a fast, and set Naboth on high
among the people.
10 Set two men, wicked fellows, before
him, and let them testify against him,
saying, ‘You cursed God and the king!’
Then carry him out, and stone him to
death.”
11 The men of his city, even the elders
and the nobles who lived in his city, did as
Jezebel had instructed them in the letters
which she had written and sent to them.
12 They proclaimed a fast, and set
Naboth on high among the people.
13 The two men, the wicked fellows,
came in and sat before him. The wicked
fellows testified against him, even against
Naboth, in the presence of the people,
saying, “Naboth cursed God and the king!”
Then they carried him out of the city and
stoned him to death with stones.
14 Then they sent to Jezebel, saying,
“Naboth has been stoned and is dead.”
15 When Jezebel heard that Naboth had
been stoned and was dead, Jezebel said to
Ahab, “Arise, take possession of the
vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, which
he refused to give you for money; for
Naboth is not alive, but dead.”
16 When Ahab heard that Naboth was
dead, Ahab rose up to go down to the
vineyard of Naboth the Jezreelite, to take
possession of it.

17 Yahweh’s word came to Elijah the
Tishbite, saying,
18 “Arise, go down to meet Ahab king of
Israel, who dwells in Samaria. Behold, he
is in the vineyard of Naboth, where he has
gone down to take possession of it.
19 You shall speak to him, saying,
‘Yahweh says, “Have you killed and also
taken possession?” ’ You shall speak to
him, saying, ‘Yahweh says, “In the place
where dogs licked the blood of Naboth,
dogs will lick your blood, even yours.” ’ ”
20 Ahab said to Elijah, “Have you found
me, my enemy?”

He answered, “I have found you,
because you have sold yourself to do that
which is evil in Yahweh’s sight.

† **21:21** or, male

21 Behold, I will bring evil on you, and
will utterly sweep you away and will cut
off from Ahab everyone who urinates
against a wall,† and him who is shut up
and him who is left at large in Israel.
22 I will make your house like the house
of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and like the
house of Baasha the son of Ahijah, for the
provocation with which you have
provoked me to anger, and have made
Israel to sin."
23 Yahweh also spoke of Jezebel, saying,
"The dogs will eat Jezebel by the rampart
of Jezreel.
24 The dogs will eat whoever dies of
Ahab in the city; and the birds of the sky
will eat whoever dies in the field."
25 But there was no one like Ahab, who
sold himself to do that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight, whom Jezebel his wife
stirred up.
26 He did very abominably in following
idols, according to all that the Amorites
did, whom Yahweh cast out before the
children of Israel.
27 When Ahab heard those words, he
tore his clothes, put sackcloth on his body,
fasted, lay in sackcloth, and went about
despondently.
28 Yahweh's word came to Elijah the
Tishbite, saying,
29 "See how Ahab humbles himself
before me? Because he humbles himself
before me, I will not bring the evil in his
days; but I will bring the evil on his house
in his son's day."

22

1 They continued three years without
war between Syria and Israel.
2 In the third year, Jehoshaphat the king
of Judah came down to the king of Israel.
3 The king of Israel said to his servants,
"You know that Ramoth Gilead is ours,
and we do nothing, and don't take it out of
the hand of the king of Syria?"
4 He said to Jehoshaphat, "Will you go
with me to battle to Ramoth Gilead?"
Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, "I
am as you are, my people as your people,
my horses as your horses."
5 Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel,
"Please inquire first for Yahweh's word."
6 Then the king of Israel gathered the
prophets together, about four hundred
men, and said to them, "Should I go
against Ramoth Gilead to battle, or should
I refrain?"
They said, "Go up; for the Lord will
deliver it into the hand of the king."
7 But Jehoshaphat said, "Isn't there here
a prophet of Yahweh, that we may inquire
of him?"
8 The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat,
"There is yet one man by whom we may
inquire of Yahweh, Micaiah the son of
Imlah; but I hate him, for he does not
prophesy good concerning me, but evil."
Jehoshaphat said, "Don't let the king say
so."
9 Then the king of Israel called an
officer, and said, "Quickly get Micaiah the
son of Imlah."
10 Now the king of Israel and
Jehoshaphat the king of Judah were
sitting each on his throne, arrayed in their
robes, in an open place at the entrance of
the gate of Samaria; and all the prophets
were prophesying before them.
11 Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah made
himself horns of iron, and said, "Yahweh
says, 'With these you will push the
Syrians, until they are consumed.' "
12 All the prophets prophesied so,
saying, "Go up to Ramoth Gilead and
prosper; for Yahweh will deliver it into
the hand of the king."
13 The messenger who went to call
Micaiah spoke to him, saying, "See now,
the prophets declare good to the king with
one mouth. Please let your word be like
the word of one of them, and speak good."
14 Micaiah said, "As Yahweh lives, what
Yahweh says to me, that I will speak."
15 When he had come to the king, the
king said to him, "Micaiah, shall we go to
Ramoth Gilead to battle, or shall we
forbear?"
He answered him, "Go up and prosper;
and Yahweh will deliver it into the hand
of the king."
16 The king said to him, "How many
times do I have to adjure you that you

speak to me nothing but the truth in Yahweh's name?"
17 He said, "I saw all Israel scattered on the mountains, as sheep that have no shepherd. Yahweh said, 'These have no master. Let them each return to his house in peace.' "
18 The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "Didn't I tell you that he would not prophesy good concerning me, but evil?"
19 Micaiah said, "Therefore hear Yahweh's word. I saw Yahweh sitting on his throne, and all the army of heaven standing by him on his right hand and on his left.
20 Yahweh said, 'Who will entice Ahab, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth Gilead?' One said one thing, and another said another.
21 A spirit came out and stood before Yahweh, and said, 'I will entice him.'
22 Yahweh said to him, 'How?'
He said, 'I will go out and will be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets.'
He said, 'You will entice him, and will also prevail. Go out and do so.'
23 Now therefore, behold, Yahweh has put a lying spirit in the mouth of all these your prophets; and Yahweh has spoken evil concerning you."
24 Then Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near and struck Micaiah on the cheek, and said, "Which way did Yahweh's Spirit go from me to speak to you?"
25 Micaiah said, "Behold, you will see on that day when you go into an inner room to hide yourself."
26 The king of Israel said, "Take Micaiah, and carry him back to Amon the governor of the city and to Joash the king's son.
27 Say, 'The king says, "Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of affliction and with water of affliction, until I come in peace." ' "
28 Micaiah said, "If you return at all in peace, Yahweh has not spoken by me." He said, "Listen, all you people!"
29 So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramoth Gilead.
30 The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "I will disguise myself and go into the battle, but you put on your robes." The king of Israel disguised himself and went into the battle.
31 Now the king of Syria had commanded the thirty-two captains of his chariots, saying, "Don't fight with small nor great, except only with the king of Israel."
32 When the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, they said, "Surely that is the king of Israel!" and they came over to fight against him. Jehoshaphat cried out.
33 When the captains of the chariots saw that it was not the king of Israel, they turned back from pursuing him.
34 A certain man drew his bow at random, and struck the king of Israel between the joints of the armor. Therefore he said to the driver of his chariot, "Turn around, and carry me out of the battle, for I am severely wounded."
35 The battle increased that day. The king was propped up in his chariot facing the Syrians, and died at evening. The blood ran out of the wound into the bottom of the chariot.
36 A cry went throughout the army about the going down of the sun, saying, "Every man to his city, and every man to his country!"
37 So the king died, and was brought to Samaria; and they buried the king in Samaria.
38 They washed the chariot by the pool of Samaria; and the dogs licked up his blood where the prostitutes washed themselves, according to Yahweh's word which he spoke.
39 Now the rest of the acts of Ahab, and all that he did, and the ivory house which he built, and all the cities that he built, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?
40 So Ahab slept with his fathers; and Ahaziah his son reigned in his place.
41 Jehoshaphat the son of Asa began to reign over Judah in the fourth year of Ahab king of Israel.
42 Jehoshaphat was thirty-five years old when he began to reign; and he reigned twenty-five years in Jerusalem. His

mother's name was Azubah the daughter
of Shilhi.
43 He walked in all the way of Asa his
father. He didn't turn away from it, doing
that which was right in Yahweh's eyes.
However, the high places were not taken
away. The people still sacrificed and
burned incense on the high places.
44 Jehoshaphat made peace with the
king of Israel.
45 Now the rest of the acts of
Jehoshaphat, and his might that he
showed, and how he fought, aren't they
written in the book of the chronicles of
the kings of Judah?
46 The remnant of the sodomites, that
remained in the days of his father Asa, he
put away out of the land.
47 There was no king in Edom. A deputy
ruled.
48 Jehoshaphat made ships of Tarshish
to go to Ophir for gold, but they didn't go,
for the ships wrecked at Ezion Geber.
49 Then Ahaziah the son of Ahab said to
Jehoshaphat, "Let my servants go with
your servants in the ships." But
Jehoshaphat would not.
50 Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers,
and was buried with his fathers in his
father David's city. Jehoram his son
reigned in his place.
51 Ahaziah the son of Ahab began to
reign over Israel in Samaria in the
seventeenth year of Jehoshaphat king of
Judah, and he reigned two years over
Israel.
52 He did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight, and walked in the way of
his father, and in the way of his mother,
and in the way of Jeroboam the son of
Nebat, in which he made Israel to sin.
53 He served Baal and worshiped him,
and provoked Yahweh, the God of Israel,
to anger in all the ways that his father had
done so.

The Second Book of Kings

1 Moab rebelled against Israel after the
death of Ahab.
2 Ahaziah fell down through the lattice
in his upper room that was in Samaria,
and was sick. So he sent messengers, and
said to them, “Go, inquire of Baal Zebub,
the god of Ekron, whether I will recover of
this sickness.”
3 But Yahweh’s† angel said to Elijah the
Tishbite, “Arise, go up to meet the
messengers of the king of Samaria, and
tell them, ‘Is it because there is no God‡ in
Israel that you go to inquire of Baal
Zebub, the god of Ekron?
4 Now therefore Yahweh says, “You will
not come down from the bed where you
have gone up, but you will surely die.” ’ ”
Then Elijah departed.
5 The messengers returned to him, and
he said to them, “Why is it that you have
returned?”
6 They said to him, “A man came up to
meet us, and said to us, ‘Go, return to the
king who sent you, and tell him, “Yahweh
says, ‘Is it because there is no God in Israel
that you send to inquire of Baal Zebub, the
god of Ekron? Therefore you will not
come down from the bed where you have
gone up, but you will surely die.’ ” ’ ”
7 He said to them, “What kind of man
was he who came up to meet you and told
you these words?”
8 They answered him, “He was a hairy
man, and wearing a leather belt around
his waist.”
He said, “It’s Elijah the Tishbite.”
9 Then the king sent a captain of fifty
with his fifty to him. He went up to him;
and behold,§ he was sitting on the top of
the hill. He said to him, “Man of God, the
king has said, ‘Come down!’ ”
10 Elijah answered to the captain of fifty,
“If I am a man of God, then let fire come
down from the sky and consume you and
your fifty!” Then fire came down from the
sky, and consumed him and his fifty.
11 Again he sent to him another captain
of fifty with his fifty. He answered him,
“Man of God, the king has said, ‘Come
down quickly!’ ”
12 Elijah answered them, “If I am a man
of God, then let fire come down from the
sky and consume you and your fifty!”
Then God’s fire came down from the sky,
and consumed him and his fifty.
13 Again he sent the captain of a third
fifty with his fifty. The third captain of
fifty went up, and came and fell on his
knees before Elijah, and begged him, and
said to him, “Man of God, please let my life
and the life of these fifty of your servants
be precious in your sight.
14 Behold, fire came down from the sky
and consumed the last two captains of
fifty with their fifties. But now let my life
be precious in your sight.”
15 Yahweh’s angel said to Elijah, “Go
down with him. Don’t be afraid of him.”
Then he arose and went down with him
to the king.
16 He said to him, “Yahweh says,
‘Because you have sent messengers to
inquire of Baal Zebub, the god of Ekron, is
it because there is no God in Israel to
inquire of his word? Therefore you will
not come down from the bed where you
have gone up, but you will surely die.’ ”
17 So he died according to Yahweh’s
word which Elijah had spoken. Jehoram
began to reign in his place in the second
year of Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat
king of Judah, because he had no son.
18 Now the rest of the acts of Ahaziah
which he did, aren’t they written in the
book of the chronicles of the kings of
Israel?

2

1 When Yahweh was about to take Elijah
up by a whirlwind into heaven, Elijah
went with Elisha from Gilgal.

† **1:3** “Yahweh” is God’s proper Name, sometimes rendered “LORD” (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:3** The Hebrew word rendered “God” is “אֱלֹהִים” (Elohim). § **1:9** “Behold”, from “הִנֵּה”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

2 Elijah said to Elisha, “Please wait here,
for Yahweh has sent me as far as Bethel.”
Elisha said, “As Yahweh lives, and as
your soul lives, I will not leave you.” So
they went down to Bethel.
3 The sons of the prophets who were at
Bethel came out to Elisha, and said to him,
“Do you know that Yahweh will take away
your master from over you today?”
He said, “Yes, I know it. Hold your
peace.”
4 Elijah said to him, “Elisha, please wait
here, for Yahweh has sent me to Jericho.”
He said, “As Yahweh lives, and as your
soul lives, I will not leave you.” So they
came to Jericho.
5 The sons of the prophets who were at
Jericho came near to Elisha, and said to
him, “Do you know that Yahweh will take
away your master from over you today?”
He answered, “Yes, I know it. Hold your
peace.”
6 Elijah said to him, “Please wait here,
for Yahweh has sent me to the Jordan.”
He said, “As Yahweh lives, and as your
soul lives, I will not leave you.” Then they
both went on.
7 Fifty men of the sons of the prophets
went and stood opposite them at a
distance; and they both stood by the
Jordan.
8 Elijah took his mantle, and rolled it up,
and struck the waters; and they were
divided here and there, so that they both
went over on dry ground.
9 When they had gone over, Elijah said
to Elisha, “Ask what I shall do for you,
before I am taken from you.”
Elisha said, “Please let a double portion
of your spirit be on me.”
10 He said, “You have asked a hard thing.
If you see me when I am taken from you, it
will be so for you; but if not, it will not be
so.”
11 As they continued on and talked,
behold, a chariot of fire and horses of fire
separated them; and Elijah went up by a
whirlwind into heaven.
12 Elisha saw it, and he cried, “My
father, my father, the chariots of Israel
and its horsemen!”
He saw him no more. Then he took hold
of his own clothes and tore them in two
pieces.
13 He also took up Elijah’s mantle that
fell from him, and went back and stood by
the bank of the Jordan.
14 He took Elijah’s mantle that fell from
him, and struck the waters, and said,
“Where is Yahweh, the God of Elijah?”
When he also had struck the waters, they
were divided apart, and Elisha went over.
15 When the sons of the prophets who
were at Jericho facing him saw him, they
said, “The spirit of Elijah rests on Elisha.”
They came to meet him, and bowed
themselves to the ground before him.
16 They said to him, “See now, there are
with your servants fifty strong men.
Please let them go and seek your master.
Perhaps Yahweh’s Spirit has taken him
up, and put him on some mountain or into
some valley.”
He said, “Don’t send them.”
17 When they urged him until he was
ashamed, he said, “Send them.”
Therefore they sent fifty men; and they
searched for three days, but didn’t find
him.
18 They came back to him while he
stayed at Jericho; and he said to them,
“Didn’t I tell you, ‘Don’t go’?”
19 The men of the city said to Elisha,
“Behold, please, the situation of this city is
pleasant, as my lord sees; but the water is
bad, and the land is barren.”
20 He said, “Bring me a new jar, and put
salt in it.” Then they brought it to him.
21 He went out to the spring of the
waters, and threw salt into it, and said,
“Yahweh says, ‘I have healed these waters.
There shall not be from there any more
death or barren wasteland.’ ”
22 So the waters were healed to this day,
according to Elisha’s word which he
spoke.
23 He went up from there to Bethel. As
he was going up by the way, some youths
came out of the city and mocked him, and
said to him, “Go up, you baldy! Go up, you
baldy!”

24 He looked behind him and saw them,
and cursed them in Yahweh's name. Then
two female bears came out of the woods
and mauled forty-two of those youths.
25 He went from there to Mount Carmel,
and from there he returned to Samaria.

3

1 Now Jehoram the son of Ahab began to
reign over Israel in Samaria in the
eighteenth year of Jehoshaphat king of
Judah, and reigned twelve years.
2 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's
sight, but not like his father and like his
mother, for he put away the pillar of Baal
that his father had made.
3 Nevertheless he held to the sins of
Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he
made Israel to sin. He didn't depart from
them.
4 Now Mesha king of Moab was a sheep
breeder; and he supplied the king of Israel
with one hundred thousand lambs and
the wool of one hundred thousand rams.
5 But when Ahab was dead, the king of
Moab rebelled against the king of Israel.
6 King Jehoram went out of Samaria at
that time, and mustered all Israel.
7 He went and sent to Jehoshaphat the
king of Judah, saying, "The king of Moab
has rebelled against me. Will you go with
me against Moab to battle?"
He said, "I will go up. I am as you are,
my people as your people, my horses as
your horses."
8 Then he said, "Which way shall we go
up?"
Jehoram answered, "The way of the
wilderness of Edom."
9 So the king of Israel went with the king
of Judah and the king of Edom, and they
marched for seven days along a circuitous
route. There was no water for the army or
for the animals that followed them.
10 The king of Israel said, "Alas! For
Yahweh has called these three kings
together to deliver them into the hand of
Moab."
11 But Jehoshaphat said, "Isn't there a
prophet of Yahweh here, that we may
inquire of Yahweh by him?"
One of the king of Israel's servants
answered, "Elisha the son of Shaphat,
who poured water on the hands of Elijah,
is here."
12 Jehoshaphat said, "Yahweh's word is
with him." So the king of Israel and
Jehoshaphat and the king of Edom went
down to him.
13 Elisha said to the king of Israel, "What
have I to do with you? Go to the prophets
of your father, and to the prophets of your
mother."
The king of Israel said to him, "No, for
Yahweh has called these three kings
together to deliver them into the hand of
Moab."
14 Elisha said, "As Yahweh of Armies
lives, before whom I stand, surely, were it
not that I respect the presence of
Jehoshaphat the king of Judah, I would
not look toward you, nor see you.
15 But now bring me a musician." When
the musician played, Yahweh's hand came
on him.
16 He said, "Yahweh says, 'Make this
valley full of trenches.'
17 For Yahweh says, 'You will not see
wind, neither will you see rain, yet that
valley will be filled with water, and you
will drink, both you and your livestock
and your other animals.
18 This is an easy thing in Yahweh's
sight. He will also deliver the Moabites
into your hand.
19 You shall strike every fortified city
and every choice city, and shall fell every
good tree, and stop all springs of water,
and mar every good piece of land with
stones.' "
20 In the morning, about the time of
offering the sacrifice, behold, water came
by the way of Edom, and the country was
filled with water.
21 Now when all the Moabites heard
that the kings had come up to fight against
them, they gathered themselves together,
all who were able to put on armor, young
and old, and stood on the border.
22 They rose up early in the morning,
and the sun shone on the water, and the
Moabites saw the water opposite them as
red as blood.
23 They said, "This is blood. The kings
are surely destroyed, and they have

struck each other. Now therefore, Moab, to the plunder!"

24 When they came to the camp of Israel, the Israelites rose up and struck the Moabites, so that they fled before them; and they went forward into the land attacking the Moabites.

25 They beat down the cities; and on every good piece of land each man cast his stone, and filled it. They also stopped all the springs of water and cut down all the good trees, until in Kir Hareseth all they left was its stones; however the men armed with slings went around it and attacked it.

26 When the king of Moab saw that the battle was too severe for him, he took with him seven hundred men who drew a sword, to break through to the king of Edom; but they could not.

27 Then he took his oldest son who would have reigned in his place, and offered him for a burnt offering on the wall. There was great wrath against Israel; and they departed from him, and returned to their own land.

4

1 Now a certain woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets cried out to Elisha, saying, "Your servant my husband is dead. You know that your servant feared Yahweh. Now the creditor has come to take for himself my two children to be slaves."

2 Elisha said to her, "What should I do for you? Tell me, what do you have in the house?"

She said, "Your servant has nothing in the house, except a pot of oil."

3 Then he said, "Go, borrow empty containers from all your neighbors. Don't borrow just a few containers.

4 Go in and shut the door on you and on your sons, and pour oil into all those containers; and set aside those which are full."

5 So she went from him, and shut the door on herself and on her sons. They brought the containers to her, and she poured oil.

6 When the containers were full, she said to her son, "Bring me another container."

He said to her, "There isn't another container." Then the oil stopped flowing.

7 Then she came and told the man of God. He said, "Go, sell the oil, and pay your debt; and you and your sons live on the rest."

8 One day Elisha went to Shunem, where there was a prominent woman; and she persuaded him to eat bread. So it was, that as often as he passed by, he turned in there to eat bread.

9 She said to her husband, "See now, I perceive that this is a holy man of God who passes by us continually.

10 Please, let's make a little room on the roof. Let's set a bed, a table, a chair, and a lamp stand for him there. When he comes to us, he can stay there."

11 One day he came there, and he went to the room and lay there.

12 He said to Gehazi his servant, "Call this Shunammite." When he had called her, she stood before him.

13 He said to him, "Say now to her, 'Behold, you have cared for us with all this care. What is to be done for you? Would you like to be spoken for to the king, or to the captain of the army?' "

She answered, "I dwell among my own people."

14 He said, "What then is to be done for her?"

Gehazi answered, "Most certainly she has no son, and her husband is old."

15 He said, "Call her." When he had called her, she stood in the door.

16 He said, "At this season next year, you will embrace a son."

She said, "No, my lord, you man of God, do not lie to your servant."

17 The woman conceived, and bore a son at that season when the time came around, as Elisha had said to her.

18 When the child was grown, one day he went out to his father to the reapers.

19 He said to his father, "My head! My head!"

He said to his servant, "Carry him to his mother."

20 When he had taken him and brought
him to his mother, he sat on her knees
until noon, and then died.
21 She went up and laid him on the man
of God's bed, and shut the door on him,
and went out.
22 She called to her husband and said,
"Please send me one of the servants, and
one of the donkeys, that I may run to the
man of God and come again."
23 He said, "Why would you want to go
to him today? It is not a new moon or a
Sabbath."
She said, "It's all right."
24 Then she saddled a donkey, and said
to her servant, "Drive, and go forward!
Don't slow down for me, unless I ask you
to."
25 So she went, and came to the man of
God to Mount Carmel. When the man of
God saw her afar off, he said to Gehazi his
servant, "Behold, there is the
Shunammite.
26 Please run now to meet her, and ask
her, 'Is it well with you? Is it well with
your husband? Is it well with your
child?' "
She answered, "It is well."
27 When she came to the man of God to
the hill, she caught hold of his feet. Gehazi
came near to thrust her away; but the
man of God said, "Leave her alone, for her
soul is troubled within her; and Yahweh
has hidden it from me, and has not told
me."
28 Then she said, "Did I ask you for a son,
my lord? Didn't I say, 'Do not deceive
me'?"
29 Then he said to Gehazi, "Tuck your
cloak into your belt, take my staff in your
hand, and go your way. If you meet any
man, don't greet him; and if anyone greets
you, don't answer him again. Then lay my
staff on the child's face."
30 The child's mother said, "As Yahweh
lives, and as your soul lives, I will not
leave you."
So he arose, and followed her.
31 Gehazi went ahead of them, and laid
the staff on the child's face; but there was
no voice and no hearing. Therefore he
returned to meet him, and told him, "The
child has not awakened."
32 When Elisha had come into the house,
behold, the child was dead, and lying on
his bed.
33 He went in therefore, and shut the
door on them both, and prayed to Yahweh.
34 He went up and lay on the child, and
put his mouth on his mouth, and his eyes
on his eyes, and his hands on his hands.
He stretched himself on him; and the
child's flesh grew warm.
35 Then he returned, and walked in the
house once back and forth, then went up
and stretched himself out on him. Then
the child sneezed seven times, and the
child opened his eyes.
36 He called Gehazi, and said, "Call this
Shunammite!" So he called her.
When she had come in to him, he said,
"Take up your son."
37 Then she went in, fell at his feet, and
bowed herself to the ground; then she
picked up her son, and went out.
38 Elisha came again to Gilgal. There
was a famine in the land; and the sons of
the prophets were sitting before him; and
he said to his servant, "Get the large pot,
and boil stew for the sons of the prophets."
39 One went out into the field to gather
herbs, and found a wild vine, and
gathered a lap full of wild gourds from it,
and came and cut them up into the pot of
stew; for they didn't recognize them.
40 So they poured out for the men to eat.
As they were eating some of the stew, they
cried out and said, "Man of God, there is
death in the pot!" And they could not eat
it.
41 But he said, "Then bring meal." He
threw it into the pot; and he said, "Serve it
to the people, that they may eat." And
there was nothing harmful in the pot.
42 A man from Baal Shalishah came, and
brought the man of God some bread of the
first fruits: twenty loaves of barley and
fresh ears of grain in his sack. Elisha said,
"Give to the people, that they may eat."
43 His servant said, "What, should I set
this before a hundred men?"
But he said, "Give it to the people, that
they may eat; for Yahweh says, 'They will
eat, and will have some left over.' "

44 So he set it before them and they ate
and had some left over, according to
Yahweh's word.

5

1 Now Naaman, captain of the army of
the king of Syria, was a great man with his
master, and honorable, because by him
Yahweh had given victory to Syria; he was
also a mighty man of valor, but he was a
leper.
2 The Syrians had gone out in bands,
and had brought away captive out of the
land of Israel a little girl, and she waited
on Naaman's wife.
3 She said to her mistress, "I wish that
my lord were with the prophet who is in
Samaria! Then he would heal him of his
leprosy."
4 Someone went in and told his lord,
saying, "The girl who is from the land of
Israel said this."
5 The king of Syria said, "Go now, and I
will send a letter to the king of Israel."
He departed, and took with him ten
talents† of silver, six thousand pieces of
gold, and ten changes of clothing.
6 He brought the letter to the king of
Israel, saying, "Now when this letter has
come to you, behold, I have sent Naaman
my servant to you, that you may heal him
of his leprosy."
7 When the king of Israel had read the
letter, he tore his clothes and said, "Am I
God, to kill and to make alive, that this
man sends to me to heal a man of his
leprosy? But please consider and see how
he seeks a quarrel against me."
8 It was so, when Elisha the man of God
heard that the king of Israel had torn his
clothes, that he sent to the king, saying,
"Why have you torn your clothes? Let him
come now to me, and he shall know that
there is a prophet in Israel."
9 So Naaman came with his horses and
with his chariots, and stood at the door of
the house of Elisha.
10 Elisha sent a messenger to him,
saying, "Go and wash in the Jordan seven
times, and your flesh shall come again to
you, and you shall be clean."
11 But Naaman was angry, and went
away and said, "Behold, I thought, 'He will
surely come out to me, and stand, and call
on the name of Yahweh his God, and wave
his hand over the place, and heal the
leper.'
12 Aren't Abanah and Pharpar, the
rivers of Damascus, better than all the
waters of Israel? Couldn't I wash in them
and be clean?" So he turned and went
away in a rage.
13 His servants came near and spoke to
him, and said, "My father, if the prophet
had asked you do some great thing,
wouldn't you have done it? How much
rather then, when he says to you, 'Wash,
and be clean'?"
14 Then went he down and dipped
himself seven times in the Jordan,
according to the saying of the man of God;
and his flesh was restored like the flesh of
a little child, and he was clean.
15 He returned to the man of God, he
and all his company, and came, and stood
before him; and he said, "See now, I know
that there is no God in all the earth, but in
Israel. Now therefore, please take a gift
from your servant."
16 But he said, "As Yahweh lives, before
whom I stand, I will receive none."
He urged him to take it; but he refused.
17 Naaman said, "If not, then, please let
two mules' load of earth be given to your
servant; for your servant will from now
on offer neither burnt offering nor
sacrifice to other gods, but to Yahweh.
18 In this thing may Yahweh pardon
your servant: when my master goes into
the house of Rimmon to worship there,
and he leans on my hand, and I bow
myself in the house of Rimmon. When I
bow myself in the house of Rimmon, may
Yahweh pardon your servant in this
thing."
19 He said to him, "Go in peace."
So he departed from him a little way.
20 But Gehazi the servant of Elisha the
man of God, said, "Behold, my master has
spared this Naaman the Syrian, in not
receiving at his hands that which he

† **5:5** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

brought. As Yahweh lives, I will run after him, and take something from him."
21 So Gehazi followed after Naaman. When Naaman saw one running after him, he came down from the chariot to meet him, and said, "Is all well?"
22 He said, "All is well. My master has sent me, saying, 'Behold, even now two young men of the sons of the prophets have come to me from the hill country of Ephraim. Please give them a talent‡ of silver and two changes of clothing.' "
23 Naaman said, "Be pleased to take two talents." He urged him, and bound two talents of silver in two bags, with two changes of clothing, and laid them on two of his servants; and they carried them before him.
24 When he came to the hill, he took them from their hand, and stored them in the house. Then he let the men go, and they departed.
25 But he went in, and stood before his master. Elisha said to him, "Where did you come from, Gehazi?"
He said, "Your servant went nowhere."
26 He said to him, "Didn't my heart go with you when the man turned from his chariot to meet you? Is it a time to receive money, and to receive garments, and olive groves and vineyards, and sheep and cattle, and male servants and female servants?
27 Therefore the leprosy of Naaman will cling to you and to your offspring§ forever."
He went out from his presence a leper, as white as snow.

6

1 The sons of the prophets said to Elisha, "See now, the place where we live and meet with you is too small for us.
2 Please let us go to the Jordan, and each man take a beam from there, and let's make us a place there, where we may live."
He answered, "Go!"
3 One said, "Please be pleased to go with your servants."
He answered, "I will go."
4 So he went with them. When they came to the Jordan, they cut down wood.
5 But as one was cutting down a tree, the ax head fell into the water. Then he cried out and said, "Alas, my master! For it was borrowed."
6 The man of God asked, "Where did it fall?" He showed him the place. He cut down a stick, threw it in there, and made the iron float.
7 He said, "Take it." So he put out his hand and took it.
8 Now the king of Syria was at war against Israel; and he took counsel with his servants, saying, "My camp will be in such and such a place."
9 The man of God sent to the king of Israel, saying, "Beware that you not pass this place, for the Syrians are coming down there."
10 The king of Israel sent to the place which the man of God told him and warned him of; and he saved himself there, not once or twice.
11 The king of Syria's heart was very troubled about this. He called his servants, and said to them, "Won't you show me which of us is for the king of Israel?"
12 One of his servants said, "No, my lord, O king; but Elisha, the prophet who is in Israel, tells the king of Israel the words that you speak in your bedroom."
13 He said, "Go and see where he is, that I may send and get him."
He was told, "Behold, he is in Dothan."
14 Therefore he sent horses, chariots, and a great army there. They came by night and surrounded the city.
15 When the servant of the man of God had risen early and gone out, behold, an army with horses and chariots was around the city. His servant said to him, "Alas, my master! What shall we do?"
16 He answered, "Don't be afraid, for those who are with us are more than those who are with them."
17 Elisha prayed, and said, "Yahweh, please open his eyes, that he may see." Yahweh opened the young man's eyes, and he saw; and behold, the mountain

‡ **5:22** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds § **5:27** or, seed

was full of horses and chariots of fire around Elisha.
18 When they came down to him, Elisha prayed to Yahweh, and said, "Please strike this people with blindness."

He struck them with blindness according to Elisha's word.

19 Elisha said to them, "This is not the way, neither is this the city. Follow me, and I will bring you to the man whom you seek." He led them to Samaria.
20 When they had come into Samaria, Elisha said, "Yahweh, open these men's eyes, that they may see."

Yahweh opened their eyes, and they saw; and behold, they were in the middle of Samaria.
21 The king of Israel said to Elisha, when he saw them, "My father, shall I strike them? Shall I strike them?"
22 He answered, "You shall not strike them. Would you strike those whom you have taken captive with your sword and with your bow? Set bread and water before them, that they may eat and drink, then go to their master."

23 He prepared a great feast for them. After they ate and drank, he sent them away and they went to their master. So the bands of Syria stopped raiding the land of Israel.
24 After this, Benhadad king of Syria gathered all his army, and went up and besieged Samaria.
25 There was a great famine in Samaria. Behold, they besieged it until a donkey's head was sold for eighty pieces of silver, and the fourth part of a kab† of dove's dung for five pieces of silver.
26 As the king of Israel was passing by on the wall, a woman cried to him, saying, "Help, my lord, O king!"

27 He said, "If Yahweh doesn't help you, where could I get help for you? From the threshing floor, or from the wine press?"
28 Then the king asked her, "What is your problem?"

She answered, "This woman said to me, 'Give your son, that we may eat him today, and we will eat my son tomorrow.'
29 So we boiled my son and ate him; and I said to her on the next day, 'Give up your son, that we may eat him;' and she has hidden her son."
30 When the king heard the words of the woman, he tore his clothes. Now he was passing by on the wall, and the people looked, and behold, he had sackcloth underneath on his body.
31 Then he said, "God do so to me, and more also, if the head of Elisha the son of Shaphat stays on him today."
32 But Elisha was sitting in his house, and the elders were sitting with him. Then the king sent a man from before him; but before the messenger came to him, he said to the elders, "Do you see how this son of a murderer has sent to take away my head? Behold, when the messenger comes, shut the door, and hold the door shut against him. Isn't the sound of his master's feet behind him?"
33 While he was still talking with them, behold, the messenger came down to him. Then he said, "Behold, this evil is from Yahweh. Why should I wait for Yahweh any longer?"

7

1 Elisha said, "Hear Yahweh's word. Yahweh says, 'Tomorrow about this time a seah† of fine flour will be sold for a shekel,‡ and two seahs of barley for a shekel, in the gate of Samaria.' "
2 Then the captain on whose hand the king leaned answered the man of God, and said, "Behold, if Yahweh made windows in heaven, could this thing be?"

He said, "Behold, you will see it with your eyes, but will not eat of it."
3 Now there were four leprous men at the entrance of the gate. They said to one another, "Why do we sit here until we die?
4 If we say, 'We will enter into the city,' then the famine is in the city, and we will die there. If we sit still here, we also die.

† **6:25** A kab was about 2 liters, so a fourth of a kab would be about 500 milliliters or about a pint † **7:1** 1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks ‡ **7:1** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. In this context, it was probably a silver coin weighing that much.

Now therefore come, and let's surrender to the army of the Syrians. If they save us alive, we will live; and if they kill us, we will only die."

5 They rose up in the twilight to go to the camp of the Syrians. When they had come to the outermost part of the camp of the Syrians, behold, no man was there.

6 For the Lord§ had made the army of the Syrians to hear the sound of chariots and the sound of horses, even the noise of a great army; and they said to one another, "Behold, the king of Israel has hired against us the kings of the Hittites and the kings of the Egyptians to attack us."

7 Therefore they arose and fled in the twilight, and left their tents, their horses, and their donkeys, even the camp as it was, and fled for their life.

8 When these lepers came to the outermost part of the camp, they went into one tent, and ate and drank, then carried away silver, gold, and clothing and went and hid it. Then they came back, and entered into another tent and carried things from there also, and went and hid them.

9 Then they said to one another, "We aren't doing right. Today is a day of good news, and we keep silent. If we wait until the morning light, punishment will overtake us. Now therefore come, let's go and tell the king's household."

10 So they came and called to the city gatekeepers; and they told them, "We came to the camp of the Syrians, and, behold, there was no man there, not even a man's voice, but the horses tied, and the donkeys tied, and the tents as they were."

11 Then the gatekeepers called out and told it to the king's household within.

12 The king arose in the night, and said to his servants, "I will now show you what the Syrians have done to us. They know that we are hungry. Therefore they have gone out of the camp to hide themselves in the field, saying, 'When they come out of the city, we shall take them alive, and get into the city.' "

13 One of his servants answered, "Please let some people take five of the horses that remain, which are left in the city. Behold, they are like all the multitude of Israel who are left in it. Behold, they are like all the multitude of Israel who are consumed. Let's send and see."

14 Therefore they took two chariots with horses; and the king sent them out to the Syrian army, saying, "Go and see."

15 They went after them to the Jordan; and behold, all the path was full of garments and equipment which the Syrians had cast away in their haste. The messengers returned and told the king.

16 The people went out and plundered the camp of the Syrians. So a seah† of fine flour was sold for a shekel, and two measures of barley for a shekel,‡ according to Yahweh's word.

17 The king had appointed the captain on whose hand he leaned to be in charge of the gate; and the people trampled over him in the gate, and he died as the man of God had said, who spoke when the king came down to him.

18 It happened as the man of God had spoken to the king, saying, "Two seahs§ of barley for a shekel,† and a seah of fine flour for a shekel, shall be tomorrow about this time in the gate of Samaria;"

19 and that captain answered the man of God, and said, "Now, behold, if Yahweh made windows in heaven, might such a thing be?" and he said, "Behold, you will see it with your eyes, but will not eat of it."

20 It happened like that to him, for the people trampled over him in the gate, and he died.

8

1 Now Elisha had spoken to the woman whose son he had restored to life, saying, "Arise, and go, you and your household,

§ **7:6** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." † **7:16** 1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks ‡ **7:16** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. In this context, it was probably a silver coin weighing that much.

§ **7:18** 1 seah is about 7 liters or 1.9 gallons or 0.8 pecks † **7:18** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. In this context, it was probably a silver coin weighing that much.

and stay for a while wherever you can; for Yahweh has called for a famine. It will also come on the land for seven years."
2 The woman arose, and did according to the man of God's word. She went with her household, and lived in the land of the Philistines for seven years.
3 At the end of seven years, the woman returned from the land of the Philistines. Then she went out to beg the king for her house and for her land.
4 Now the king was talking with Gehazi the servant of the man of God, saying, "Please tell me all the great things that Elisha has done."
5 As he was telling the king how he had restored to life him who was dead, behold, the woman whose son he had restored to life begged the king for her house and for her land. Gehazi said, "My lord, O king, this is the woman, and this is her son, whom Elisha restored to life."
6 When the king asked the woman, she told him. So the king appointed to her a certain officer, saying, "Restore all that was hers, and all the fruits of the field since the day that she left the land, even until now."
7 Elisha came to Damascus; and Benhadad the king of Syria was sick. He was told, "The man of God has come here."
8 The king said to Hazael, "Take a present in your hand, and go meet the man of God, and inquire of Yahweh by him, saying, 'Will I recover from this sickness?' "
9 So Hazael went to meet him and took a present with him, even of every good thing of Damascus, forty camels' burden, and came and stood before him and said, "Your son Benhadad king of Syria has sent me to you, saying, 'Will I recover from this sickness?' "
10 Elisha said to him, "Go, tell him, 'You will surely recover;' however Yahweh has shown me that he will surely die."
11 He settled his gaze steadfastly on him, until he was ashamed. Then the man of God wept.
12 Hazael said, "Why do you weep, my lord?"
He answered, "Because I know the evil that you will do to the children of Israel. You will set their strongholds on fire, and you will kill their young men with the sword, and will dash their little ones in pieces, and rip up their pregnant women."
13 Hazael said, "But what is your servant, who is but a dog, that he could do this great thing?"
Elisha answered, "Yahweh has shown me that you will be king over Syria."
14 Then he departed from Elisha, and came to his master, who said to him, "What did Elisha say to you?"
He answered, "He told me that you would surely recover."
15 On the next day, he took a thick cloth, dipped it in water, and spread it on the king's face, so that he died. Then Hazael reigned in his place.
16 In the fifth year of Joram the son of Ahab king of Israel, Jehoshaphat being king of Judah then, Jehoram the son of Jehoshaphat king of Judah began to reign.
17 He was thirty-two years old when he began to reign. He reigned eight years in Jerusalem.
18 He walked in the way of the kings of Israel, as did Ahab's house, for he married Ahab's daughter. He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight.
19 However, Yahweh would not destroy Judah, for David his servant's sake, as he promised him to give to him a lamp for his children always.
20 In his days Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah, and made a king over themselves.
21 Then Joram crossed over to Zair, and all his chariots with him; and he rose up by night and struck the Edomites who surrounded him with the captains of the chariots; and the people fled to their tents.
22 So Edom revolted from under the hand of Judah to this day. Then Libnah revolted at the same time.
23 The rest of the acts of Joram, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?
24 Joram slept with his fathers, and was buried with his fathers in David's city; and Ahaziah his son reigned in his place.

25 In the twelfth year of Joram the son of
Ahab king of Israel, Ahaziah the son of
Jehoram king of Judah began to reign.
26 Ahaziah was twenty-two years old
when he began to reign; and he reigned
one year in Jerusalem. His mother's name
was Athaliah the daughter of Omri king of
Israel.
27 He walked in the way of Ahab's house
and did that which was evil in Yahweh's
sight, as did Ahab's house, for he was the
son-in-law of Ahab's house.
28 He went with Joram the son of Ahab
to war against Hazael king of Syria at
Ramoth Gilead, and the Syrians wounded
Joram.
29 King Joram returned to be healed in
Jezreel from the wounds which the
Syrians had given him at Ramah, when he
fought against Hazael king of Syria.
Ahaziah the son of Jehoram, king of
Judah, went down to see Joram the son of
Ahab in Jezreel, because he was sick.

9

1 Elisha the prophet called one of the
sons of the prophets, and said to him, "Put
your belt on your waist, take this vial of
oil in your hand, and go to Ramoth Gilead.
2 When you come there, find Jehu the
son of Jehoshaphat the son of Nimshi, and
go in and make him rise up from among
his brothers, and take him to an inner
room.
3 Then take the vial of oil, and pour it on
his head, and say, 'Yahweh says, "I have
anointed you king over Israel." ' Then
open the door, flee, and don't wait."
4 So the young man, the young prophet,
went to Ramoth Gilead.
5 When he came, behold, the captains of
the army were sitting. Then he said, "I
have a message for you, captain."

Jehu said, "To which one of us?"

He said, "To you, O captain."
6 He arose, and went into the house.
Then he poured the oil on his head, and
said to him, "Yahweh, the God of Israel,
says, 'I have anointed you king over the
people of Yahweh, even over Israel.
7 You must strike your master Ahab's
house, that I may avenge the blood of my
servants the prophets, and the blood of all
the servants of Yahweh, at the hand of
Jezebel.
8 For the whole house of Ahab will
perish. I will cut off from Ahab everyone
who urinates against a wall,† both him
who is shut up and him who is left at large
in Israel.
9 I will make Ahab's house like the
house of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, and
like the house of Baasha the son of Ahijah.
10 The dogs will eat Jezebel on the plot of
ground of Jezreel, and there shall be no
one to bury her.' " Then he opened the
door and fled.
11 When Jehu came out to the servants
of his lord and one said to him, "Is all well?
Why did this madman come to you?"

He said to them, "You know the man
and how he talks."
12 They said, "That is a lie. Tell us now."

He said, "He said to me, 'Yahweh says, I
have anointed you king over Israel.' "
13 Then they hurried, and each man
took his cloak, and put it under him on the
top of the stairs, and blew the trumpet,
saying, "Jehu is king."
14 So Jehu the son of Jehoshaphat the
son of Nimshi conspired against Joram.
(Now Joram was defending Ramoth
Gilead, he and all Israel, because of
Hazael king of Syria;
15 but King Joram had returned to be
healed in Jezreel of the wounds which the
Syrians had given him when he fought
with Hazael king of Syria.) Jehu said, "If
this is your thinking, then let no one
escape and go out of the city to go to tell it
in Jezreel."
16 So Jehu rode in a chariot and went to
Jezreel, for Joram lay there. Ahaziah king
of Judah had come down to see Joram.
17 Now the watchman was standing on
the tower in Jezreel, and he spied the
company of Jehu as he came, and said, "I
see a company."

† **9:8** or, male

Joram said, “Take a horseman, and send to meet them, and let him say, ‘Is it peace?’ ”
18 So one went on horseback to meet him, and said, “the king says, ‘Is it peace?’ ”
Jehu said, “What do you have to do with peace? Fall in behind me!”
The watchman said, “The messenger came to them, but he isn’t coming back.”
19 Then he sent out a second on horseback, who came to them and said, “The king says, ‘Is it peace?’ ”
Jehu answered, “What do you have to do with peace? Fall in behind me!”
20 The watchman said, “He came to them, and isn’t coming back. The driving is like the driving of Jehu the son of Nimshi, for he drives furiously.”
21 Joram said, “Get ready!”
They got his chariot ready. Then Joram king of Israel and Ahaziah king of Judah went out, each in his chariot; and they went out to meet Jehu, and found him on Naboth the Jezreelite’s land.
22 When Joram saw Jehu, he said, “Is it peace, Jehu?”
He answered, “What peace, so long as the prostitution of your mother Jezebel and her witchcraft abound?”
23 Joram turned his hands and fled, and said to Ahaziah, “This is treason, Ahaziah!”
24 Jehu drew his bow with his full strength, and struck Joram between his arms; and the arrow went out at his heart, and he sunk down in his chariot.
25 Then Jehu said to Bidkar his captain, “Pick him up, and throw him in the plot of the field of Naboth the Jezreelite; for remember how, when you and I rode together after Ahab his father, Yahweh laid this burden on him:
26 ‘Surely I have seen yesterday the blood of Naboth, and the blood of his sons,’ says Yahweh; ‘and I will repay you in this plot of ground,’ says Yahweh. Now therefore take and cast him onto the plot of ground, according to Yahweh’s word.”
27 But when Ahaziah the king of Judah saw this, he fled by the way of the garden house. Jehu followed after him, and said, “Strike him also in the chariot!” They struck him at the ascent of Gur, which is by Ibleam. He fled to Megiddo, and died there.
28 His servants carried him in a chariot to Jerusalem, and buried him in his tomb with his fathers in David’s city.
29 In the eleventh year of Joram the son of Ahab, Ahaziah began to reign over Judah.
30 When Jehu had come to Jezreel, Jezebel heard of it; and she painted her eyes, and adorned her head, and looked out at the window.
31 As Jehu entered in at the gate, she said, “Do you come in peace, Zimri, you murderer of your master?”
32 He lifted up his face to the window, and said, “Who is on my side? Who?”
Two or three eunuchs looked out at him.
33 He said, “Throw her down!”
So they threw her down; and some of her blood was sprinkled on the wall, and on the horses. Then he trampled her under foot.
34 When he had come in, he ate and drank. Then he said, “See now to this cursed woman, and bury her; for she is a king’s daughter.”
35 They went to bury her, but they found no more of her than the skull, the feet, and the palms of her hands.
36 Therefore they came back, and told him.
He said, “This is Yahweh’s word, which he spoke by his servant Elijah the Tishbite, saying, ‘The dogs will eat the flesh of Jezebel on the plot of Jezreel,
37 and the body of Jezebel will be as dung on the surface of the field on Jezreel’s land, so that they won’t say, “This is Jezebel.” ’ ”

10

1 Now Ahab had seventy sons in Samaria. Jehu wrote letters and sent them to Samaria, to the rulers of Jezreel, even the elders, and to those who brought up Ahab’s sons, saying,
2 “Now as soon as this letter comes to you, since your master’s sons are with

you, and you have chariots and horses, a fortified city also, and armor,
3 select the best and fittest of your master's sons, set him on his father's throne, and fight for your master's house."
4 But they were exceedingly afraid, and said, "Behold, the two kings didn't stand before him! How then shall we stand?"
5 He who was over the household, and he who was over the city, the elders also, and those who raised the children, sent to Jehu, saying, "We are your servants, and will do all that you ask us. We will not make any man king. You do that which is good in your eyes."
6 Then he wrote a letter the second time to them, saying, "If you are on my side, and if you will listen to my voice, take the heads of the men who are your master's sons, and come to me to Jezreel by tomorrow this time."
Now the king's sons, being seventy persons, were with the great men of the city, who brought them up.
7 When the letter came to them, they took the king's sons and killed them, even seventy people, and put their heads in baskets, and sent them to him to Jezreel.
8 A messenger came and told him, "They have brought the heads of the king's sons."
He said, "Lay them in two heaps at the entrance of the gate until the morning."
9 In the morning, he went out and stood, and said to all the people, "You are righteous. Behold, I conspired against my master and killed him, but who killed all these?
10 Know now that nothing will fall to the earth of Yahweh's word, which Yahweh spoke concerning Ahab's house. For Yahweh has done that which he spoke by his servant Elijah."
11 So Jehu struck all that remained of Ahab's house in Jezreel, with all his great men, his familiar friends, and his priests, until he left him no one remaining.
12 He arose and departed, and went to Samaria. As he was at the shearing house of the shepherds on the way,
13 Jehu met with the brothers of Ahaziah king of Judah, and said, "Who are you?"
They answered, "We are the brothers of Ahaziah. We are going down to greet the children of the king and the children of the queen."
14 He said, "Take them alive!"
They took them alive, and killed them at the pit of the shearing house, even forty-two men. He didn't leave any of them.
15 When he had departed from there, he met Jehonadab the son of Rechab coming to meet him. He greeted him, and said to him, "Is your heart right, as my heart is with your heart?"
Jehonadab answered, "It is."
"If it is, give me your hand." He gave him his hand; and he took him up to him into the chariot.
16 He said, "Come with me, and see my zeal for Yahweh." So they made him ride in his chariot.
17 When he came to Samaria, he struck all who remained to Ahab in Samaria, until he had destroyed them, according to Yahweh's word which he spoke to Elijah.
18 Jehu gathered all the people together, and said to them, "Ahab served Baal a little, but Jehu will serve him much.
19 Now therefore call to me all the prophets of Baal, all of his worshipers, and all of his priests. Let no one be absent, for I have a great sacrifice to Baal. Whoever is absent, he shall not live." But Jehu did deceptively, intending to destroy the worshipers of Baal.
20 Jehu said, "Sanctify a solemn assembly for Baal!"
So they proclaimed it.
21 Jehu sent through all Israel; and all the worshipers of Baal came, so that there was not a man left that didn't come. They came into the house of Baal; and the house of Baal was filled from one end to another.
22 He said to him who kept the wardrobe, "Bring out robes for all the worshipers of Baal!"
So he brought robes out to them.
23 Jehu went with Jehonadab the son of Rechab into the house of Baal. Then he said to the worshipers of Baal, "Search, and see that none of the servants of

Yahweh are here with you, but only the worshipers of Baal."

24 So they went in to offer sacrifices and burnt offerings. Now Jehu had appointed for himself eighty men outside, and said, "If any of the men whom I bring into your hands escape, he who lets him go, his life shall be for the life of him."

25 As soon as he had finished offering the burnt offering, Jehu said to the guard and to the captains, "Go in and kill them! Let no one escape." So they struck them with the edge of the sword. The guard and the captains threw the bodies out, and went to the inner shrine of the house of Baal.
26 They brought out the pillars that were in the house of Baal and burned them.
27 They broke down the pillar of Baal, and broke down the house of Baal, and made it a latrine, to this day.
28 Thus Jehu destroyed Baal out of Israel.

29 However, Jehu didn't depart from the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin—the golden calves that were in Bethel and that were in Dan.
30 Yahweh said to Jehu, "Because you have done well in executing that which is right in my eyes, and have done to Ahab's house according to all that was in my heart, your descendants shall sit on the throne of Israel to the fourth generation."

31 But Jehu took no heed to walk in the law of Yahweh, the God of Israel, with all his heart. He didn't depart from the sins of Jeroboam, with which he made Israel to sin.

32 In those days Yahweh began to cut away parts of Israel; and Hazael struck them in all the borders of Israel
33 from the Jordan eastward, all the land of Gilead, the Gadites, and the Reubenites, and the Manassites, from Aroer, which is by the valley of the Arnon, even Gilead and Bashan.
34 Now the rest of the acts of Jehu, and all that he did, and all his might, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?
35 Jehu slept with his fathers; and they buried him in Samaria. Jehoahaz his son reigned in his place.
36 The time that Jehu reigned over Israel in Samaria was twenty-eight years.

11

1 Now when Athaliah the mother of Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she arose and destroyed all the royal offspring.
2 But Jehosheba, the daughter of King Joram, sister of Ahaziah, took Joash the son of Ahaziah, and stole him away from among the king's sons who were slain, even him and his nurse, and put them in the bedroom; and they hid him from Athaliah, so that he was not slain.
3 He was with her hidden in Yahweh's house six years while Athaliah reigned over the land.
4 In the seventh year Jehoiada sent and fetched the captains over hundreds of the Carites and of the guard, and brought them to him into Yahweh's house; and he made a covenant with them, and made a covenant with them in Yahweh's house, and showed them the king's son.
5 He commanded them, saying, "This is what you must do: a third of you, who come in on the Sabbath, shall be keepers of the watch of the king's house;
6 a third of you shall be at the gate Sur; and a third of you at the gate behind the guard. So you shall keep the watch of the house, and be a barrier.
7 The two companies of you, even all who go out on the Sabbath, shall keep the watch of Yahweh's house around the king.
8 You shall surround the king, every man with his weapons in his hand; and he who comes within the ranks, let him be slain. Be with the king when he goes out, and when he comes in."
9 The captains over hundreds did according to all that Jehoiada the priest commanded; and they each took his men, those who were to come in on the Sabbath with those who were to go out on the Sabbath, and came to Jehoiada the priest.
10 The priest delivered to the captains over hundreds the spears and shields that

had been King David's, which were in Yahweh's house.
11 The guard stood, every man with his weapons in his hand, from the right side of the house to the left side of the house, along by the altar and the house, around the king.
12 Then he brought out the king's son, and put the crown on him, and gave him the covenant; and they made him king and anointed him; and they clapped their hands, and said, "Long live the king!"

13 When Athaliah heard the noise of the guard and of the people, she came to the people into Yahweh's house;
14 and she looked, and behold, the king stood by the pillar, as the tradition was, with the captains and the trumpets by the king; and all the people of the land rejoiced, and blew trumpets. Then Athaliah tore her clothes and cried, "Treason! Treason!"

15 Jehoiada the priest commanded the captains of hundreds who were set over the army, and said to them, "Bring her out between the ranks. Kill anyone who follows her with the sword." For the priest said, "Don't let her be slain in Yahweh's house."
16 So they seized her; and she went by the way of the horses' entry to the king's house, and she was slain there.

17 Jehoiada made a covenant between Yahweh and the king and the people, that they should be Yahweh's people; also between the king and the people.
18 All the people of the land went to the house of Baal, and broke it down. They broke his altars and his images in pieces thoroughly, and killed Mattan the priest of Baal before the altars. The priest appointed officers over Yahweh's house.
19 He took the captains over hundreds, and the Carites, and the guard, and all the people of the land; and they brought down the king from Yahweh's house, and came by the way of the gate of the guard to the king's house. He sat on the throne of the kings.

20 So all the people of the land rejoiced, and the city was quiet. They had slain Athaliah with the sword at the king's house.
21 Jehoash was seven years old when he began to reign.

12

1 Jehoash began to reign in the seventh year of Jehu, and he reigned forty years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Zibiah of Beersheba.
2 Jehoash did that which was right in Yahweh's eyes all his days in which Jehoiada the priest instructed him.
3 However, the high places were not taken away. The people still sacrificed and burned incense in the high places.
4 Jehoash said to the priests, "All the money of the holy things that is brought into Yahweh's house, in current money, the money of the people for whom each man is evaluated,* and all the money that it comes into any man's heart to bring into Yahweh's house,
5 let the priests take it to them, each man from his donor; and they shall repair the damage to the house, wherever any damage is found."
6 But it was so, that in the twenty-third year of King Jehoash the priests had not repaired the damage to the house.
7 Then King Jehoash called for Jehoiada the priest, and for the other priests, and said to them, "Why aren't you repairing the damage to the house? Now therefore take no more money from your treasurers, but deliver it for repair of the damage to the house."
8 The priests consented that they should take no more money from the people, and not repair the damage to the house.
9 But Jehoiada the priest took a chest and bored a hole in its lid, and set it beside the altar, on the right side as one comes into Yahweh's house; and the priests who kept the threshold put all the money that was brought into Yahweh's house into it.
10 When they saw that there was much money in the chest, the king's scribe and

* **12:4** Exodus 30:12

the high priest came up, and they put it in bags and counted the money that was found in Yahweh's house.
11 They gave the money that was weighed out into the hands of those who did the work, who had the oversight of Yahweh's house; and they paid it out to the carpenters and the builders who worked on Yahweh's house,
12 and to the masons and the stone cutters, and for buying timber and cut stone to repair the damage to Yahweh's house, and for all that was laid out for the house to repair it.
13 But there were not made for Yahweh's house cups of silver, snuffers, basins, trumpets, any vessels of gold or vessels of silver, of the money that was brought into Yahweh's house;
14 for they gave that to those who did the work, and repaired Yahweh's house with it.
15 Moreover they didn't demand an accounting from the men into whose hand they delivered the money to give to those who did the work; for they dealt faithfully.
16 The money for the trespass offerings and the money for the sin offerings was not brought into Yahweh's house. It was the priests'.

17 Then Hazael king of Syria went up and fought against Gath, and took it; and Hazael set his face to go up to Jerusalem.
18 Jehoash king of Judah took all the holy things that Jehoshaphat and Jehoram and Ahaziah, his fathers, kings of Judah, had dedicated, and his own holy things, and all the gold that was found in the treasures of Yahweh's house, and of the king's house, and sent it to Hazael king of Syria; and he went away from Jerusalem.

19 Now the rest of the acts of Joash, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?
20 His servants arose and made a conspiracy, and struck Joash at the house of Millo, on the way that goes down to Silla.
21 For Jozacar the son of Shimeath, and Jehozabad the son of Shomer, his servants, struck him, and he died; and they buried him with his fathers in David's city; and Amaziah his son reigned in his place.

13

1 In the twenty-third year of Joash the son of Ahaziah, king of Judah, Jehoahaz the son of Jehu began to reign over Israel in Samaria for seventeen years.
2 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, and followed the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin. He didn't depart from it.
3 Yahweh's anger burned against Israel, and he delivered them into the hand of Hazael king of Syria, and into the hand of Benhadad the son of Hazael, continually.
4 Jehoahaz begged Yahweh, and Yahweh listened to him; for he saw the oppression of Israel, how the king of Syria oppressed them.
5 (Yahweh gave Israel a savior, so that they went out from under the hand of the Syrians; and the children of Israel lived in their tents as before.
6 Nevertheless they didn't depart from the sins of the house of Jeroboam, with which he made Israel to sin, but walked in them; and the Asherah also remained in Samaria.)
7 For he didn't leave to Jehoahaz of the people any more than fifty horsemen, and ten chariots, and ten thousand footmen; for the king of Syria destroyed them and made them like the dust in threshing.
8 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoahaz, and all that he did, and his might, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?
9 Jehoahaz slept with his fathers; and they buried him in Samaria; and Joash his son reigned in his place.
10 In the thirty-seventh year of Joash king of Judah, Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz began to reign over Israel in Samaria for sixteen years.
11 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight. He didn't depart from all the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat,

with which he made Israel to sin; but he walked in them.
12 Now the rest of the acts of Joash, and all that he did, and his might with which he fought against Amaziah king of Judah, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Israel?
13 Joash slept with his fathers; and Jeroboam sat on his throne. Joash was buried in Samaria with the kings of Israel.
14 Now Elisha became sick with the illness of which he died; and Joash the king of Israel came down to him, and wept over him, and said, "My father, my father, the chariots of Israel and its horsemen!"
15 Elisha said to him, "Take bow and arrows;" and he took bow and arrows for himself.
16 He said to the king of Israel, "Put your hand on the bow;" and he put his hand on it. Elisha laid his hands on the king's hands.
17 He said, "Open the window eastward;" and he opened it. Then Elisha said, "Shoot!" and he shot. He said, "Yahweh's arrow of victory, even the arrow of victory over Syria; for you will strike the Syrians in Aphek until you have consumed them."
18 He said, "Take the arrows;" and he took them. He said to the king of Israel, "Strike the ground;" and he struck three times, and stopped.
19 The man of God was angry with him, and said, "You should have struck five or six times. Then you would have struck Syria until you had consumed it, but now you will strike Syria just three times."
20 Elisha died, and they buried him.

Now the bands of the Moabites invaded the land at the coming in of the year.
21 As they were burying a man, behold, they saw a band of raiders; and they threw the man into Elisha's tomb. As soon as the man touched Elisha's bones, he revived, and stood up on his feet.
22 Hazael king of Syria oppressed Israel all the days of Jehoahaz.
23 But Yahweh was gracious to them, and had compassion on them, and favored them because of his covenant with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and would not destroy them and he didn't cast them from his presence as yet.
24 Hazael king of Syria died; and Benhadad his son reigned in his place.
25 Jehoash the son of Jehoahaz took again out of the hand of Benhadad the son of Hazael the cities which he had taken out of the hand of Jehoahaz his father by war. Joash struck him three times, and recovered the cities of Israel.

14

1 In the second year of Joash, son of Joahaz, king of Israel, Amaziah the son of Joash king of Judah began to reign.
2 He was twenty-five years old when he began to reign; and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Jehoaddin of Jerusalem.
3 He did that which was right in Yahweh's eyes, yet not like David his father. He did according to all that Joash his father had done.
4 However the high places were not taken away. The people still sacrificed and burned incense in the high places.
5 As soon as the kingdom was established in his hand, he killed his servants who had slain the king his father,
6 but the children of the murderers he didn't put to death, according to that which is written in the book of the law of Moses, as Yahweh commanded, saying, "The fathers shall not be put to death for the children, nor the children be put to death for the fathers; but every man shall die for his own sin."
7 He killed ten thousand Edomites in the Valley of Salt, and took Sela by war, and called its name Joktheel, to this day.
8 Then Amaziah sent messengers to Jehoash, the son of Jehoahaz son of Jehu, king of Israel, saying, "Come, let's look one another in the face."
9 Jehoash the king of Israel sent to Amaziah king of Judah, saying, "The thistle that was in Lebanon sent to the cedar that was in Lebanon, saying, 'Give your daughter to my son as wife.' Then a wild animal that was in Lebanon passed by, and trampled down the thistle.

10 You have indeed struck Edom, and
your heart has lifted you up. Enjoy the
glory of it, and stay at home; for why
should you meddle to your harm, that you
fall, even you, and Judah with you?"

11 But Amaziah would not listen. So
Jehoash king of Israel went up; and he
and Amaziah king of Judah looked one
another in the face at Beth Shemesh,
which belongs to Judah.

12 Judah was defeated by Israel; and
each man fled to his tent.

13 Jehoash king of Israel took Amaziah
king of Judah, the son of Jehoash the son
of Ahaziah, at Beth Shemesh and came to
Jerusalem, then broke down the wall of
Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim to the
corner gate, four hundred cubits.†

14 He took all the gold and silver and all
the vessels that were found in Yahweh's
house and in the treasures of the king's
house, the hostages also, and returned to
Samaria.

15 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoash
which he did, and his might, and how he
fought with Amaziah king of Judah, aren't
they written in the book of the chronicles
of the kings of Israel?

16 Jehoash slept with his fathers, and
was buried in Samaria with the kings of
Israel; and Jeroboam his son reigned in
his place.

17 Amaziah the son of Joash king of
Judah lived after the death of Jehoash son
of Jehoahaz, king of Israel, fifteen years.

18 Now the rest of the acts of Amaziah,
aren't they written in the book of the
chronicles of the kings of Judah?

19 They made a conspiracy against him
in Jerusalem, and he fled to Lachish; but
they sent after him to Lachish and killed
him there.

20 They brought him on horses, and he
was buried at Jerusalem with his fathers
in David's city.

21 All the people of Judah took Azariah,
who was sixteen years old, and made him
king in the place of his father Amaziah.

22 He built Elath and restored it to Judah.
After that the king slept with his fathers.

23 In the fifteenth year of Amaziah the
son of Joash king of Judah, Jeroboam the
son of Joash king of Israel began to reign
in Samaria for forty-one years.

24 He did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight. He didn't depart from all
the sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat,
with which he made Israel to sin.

25 He restored the border of Israel from
the entrance of Hamath to the sea of the
Arabah, according to Yahweh, the God of
Israel's word, which he spoke by his
servant Jonah the son of Amittai, the
prophet, who was from Gath Hepher.

26 For Yahweh saw the affliction of
Israel, that it was very bitter for all, slave
and free; and there was no helper for
Israel.

27 Yahweh didn't say that he would blot
out the name of Israel from under the sky;
but he saved them by the hand of
Jeroboam the son of Joash.

28 Now the rest of the acts of Jeroboam,
and all that he did, and his might, how he
fought, and how he recovered Damascus,
and Hamath, which had belonged to
Judah, for Israel, aren't they written in the
book of the chronicles of the kings of
Israel?

29 Jeroboam slept with his fathers, even
with the kings of Israel; and Zechariah his
son reigned in his place.

15

1 In the twenty-seventh year of
Jeroboam king of Israel, Azariah son of
Amaziah king of Judah began to reign.

2 He was sixteen years old when he
began to reign, and he reigned fifty-two
years in Jerusalem. His mother's name
was Jecoliah of Jerusalem.

3 He did that which was right in
Yahweh's eyes, according to all that his
father Amaziah had done.

4 However, the high places were not
taken away. The people still sacrificed
and burned incense in the high places.

† **14:13** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

5 Yahweh struck the king, so that he was
a leper to the day of his death, and lived in
a separate house. Jotham, the king's son,
was over the household, judging the
people of the land.
6 Now the rest of the acts of Azariah,
and all that he did, aren't they written in
the book of the chronicles of the kings of
Judah?
7 Azariah slept with his fathers; and
they buried him with his fathers in
David's city; and Jotham his son reigned
in his place.

8 In the thirty-eighth year of Azariah
king of Judah, Zechariah the son of
Jeroboam reigned over Israel in Samaria
six months.
9 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's
sight, as his fathers had done. He didn't
depart from the sins of Jeroboam the son
of Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin.
10 Shallum the son of Jabesh conspired
against him, and struck him before the
people and killed him, and reigned in his
place.
11 Now the rest of the acts of Zechariah,
behold, they are written in the book of the
chronicles of the kings of Israel.
12 This was Yahweh's word which he
spoke to Jehu, saying, "Your sons to the
fourth generation shall sit on the throne
of Israel." So it came to pass.

13 Shallum the son of Jabesh began to
reign in the thirty-ninth year of Uzziah
king of Judah, and he reigned for a month
in Samaria.
14 Menahem the son of Gadi went up
from Tirzah, came to Samaria, struck
Shallum the son of Jabesh in Samaria,
killed him, and reigned in his place.
15 Now the rest of the acts of Shallum,
and his conspiracy which he made,
behold, they are written in the book of the
chronicles of the kings of Israel.

16 Then Menahem attacked Tiphsah and
all who were in it and its border areas,
from Tirzah. He attacked it because they
didn't open their gates to him, and he
ripped up all their women who were with
child.
17 In the thirty ninth year of Azariah
king of Judah, Menahem the son of Gadi
began to reign over Israel for ten years in
Samaria.
18 He did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight. He didn't depart all his
days from the sins of Jeroboam the son of
Nebat, with which he made Israel to sin.
19 Pul the king of Assyria came against
the land, and Menahem gave Pul one
thousand talents† of silver, that his hand
might be with him to confirm the
kingdom in his hand.
20 Menahem exacted the money from
Israel, even from all the mighty men of
wealth, from each man fifty shekels‡ of
silver, to give to the king of Assyria. So the
king of Assyria turned back, and didn't
stay there in the land.
21 Now the rest of the acts of Menahem,
and all that he did, aren't they written in
the book of the chronicles of the kings of
Israel?
22 Menahem slept with his fathers, and
Pekahiah his son reigned in his place.
23 In the fiftieth year of Azariah king of
Judah, Pekahiah the son of Menahem
began to reign over Israel in Samaria for
two years.
24 He did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight. He didn't depart from the
sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with
which he made Israel to sin.
25 Pekah the son of Remaliah, his
captain, conspired against him and
attacked him in Samaria, in the fortress of
the king's house, with Argob and Arieh;
and with him were fifty men of the
Gileadites. He killed him, and reigned in
his place.
26 Now the rest of the acts of Pekahiah,
and all that he did, behold, they are
written in the book of the chronicles of
the kings of Israel.
27 In the fifty-second year of Azariah
king of Judah, Pekah the son of Remaliah
began to reign over Israel in Samaria for
twenty years.

† **15:19** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds, so 1000 talents is about 30 metric tons ‡ **15:20** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 50 shekels was about 0.5 kilograms or 1.1 pounds.

28 He did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight. He didn't depart from the
sins of Jeroboam the son of Nebat, with
which he made Israel to sin.
29 In the days of Pekah king of Israel,
Tiglath Pileser king of Assyria came and
took Ijon, Abel Beth Maacah, Janoah,
Kedesh, Hazor, Gilead, and Galilee, all the
land of Naphtali; and he carried them
captive to Assyria.
30 Hoshea the son of Elah made a
conspiracy against Pekah the son of
Remaliah, attacked him, killed him, and
reigned in his place, in the twentieth year
of Jotham the son of Uzziah.
31 Now the rest of the acts of Pekah, and
all that he did, behold, they are written in
the book of the chronicles of the kings of
Israel.
32 In the second year of Pekah the son of
Remaliah king of Israel, Jotham the son of
Uzziah king of Judah began to reign.
33 He was twenty-five years old when he
began to reign, and he reigned sixteen
years in Jerusalem. His mother's name
was Jerusha the daughter of Zadok.
34 He did that which was right in
Yahweh's eyes. He did according to all
that his father Uzziah had done.
35 However the high places were not
taken away. The people still sacrificed
and burned incense in the high places. He
built the upper gate of Yahweh's house.
36 Now the rest of the acts of Jotham,
and all that he did, aren't they written in
the book of the chronicles of the kings of
Judah?
37 In those days, Yahweh began to send
Rezin the king of Syria and Pekah the son
of Remaliah against Judah.
38 Jotham slept with his fathers, and was
buried with his fathers in his father
David's city; and Ahaz his son reigned in
his place.

16

1 In the seventeenth year of Pekah the
son of Remaliah, Ahaz the son of Jotham
king of Judah began to reign.
2 Ahaz was twenty years old when he
began to reign, and he reigned sixteen
years in Jerusalem. He didn't do that
which was right in Yahweh his God's eyes,
like David his father.
3 But he walked in the way of the kings
of Israel, and even made his son to pass
through the fire, according to the
abominations of the nations whom
Yahweh cast out from before the children
of Israel.
4 He sacrificed and burned incense in
the high places, on the hills, and under
every green tree.

5 Then Rezin king of Syria and Pekah
son of Remaliah king of Israel came up to
Jerusalem to wage war. They besieged
Ahaz, but could not overcome him.
6 At that time Rezin king of Syria
recovered Elath to Syria, and drove the
Jews from Elath; and the Syrians came to
Elath, and lived there to this day.
7 So Ahaz sent messengers to Tiglath
Pileser king of Assyria, saying, "I am your
servant and your son. Come up and save
me out of the hand of the king of Syria and
out of the hand of the king of Israel, who
rise up against me."
8 Ahaz took the silver and gold that was
found in Yahweh's house, and in the
treasures of the king's house, and sent it
for a present to the king of Assyria.
9 The king of Assyria listened to him;
and the king of Assyria went up against
Damascus and took it, and carried its
people captive to Kir, and killed Rezin.

10 King Ahaz went to Damascus to meet
Tiglath Pileser king of Assyria, and saw
the altar that was at Damascus; and King
Ahaz sent to Urijah the priest a drawing of
the altar and plans to build it.
11 Urijah the priest built an altar.
According to all that King Ahaz had sent
from Damascus, so Urijah the priest made
it for the coming of King Ahaz from
Damascus.
12 When the king had come from
Damascus, the king saw the altar; and the
king came near to the altar, and offered
on it.
13 He burned his burnt offering and his
meal offering, poured his drink offering,
and sprinkled the blood of his peace
offerings on the altar.

14 The bronze altar, which was before
Yahweh, he brought from the front of the
house, from between his altar and
Yahweh's house, and put it on the north
side of his altar.
15 King Ahaz commanded Urijah the
priest, saying, "On the great altar burn the
morning burnt offering, the evening meal
offering, the king's burnt offering and his
meal offering, with the burnt offering of
all the people of the land, their meal
offering, and their drink offerings; and
sprinkle on it all the blood of the burnt
offering, and all the blood of the sacrifice;
but the bronze altar will be for me to
inquire by."
16 Urijah the priest did so, according to
all that King Ahaz commanded.
17 King Ahaz cut off the panels of the
bases, and removed the basin from off
them, and took down the sea from off the
bronze oxen that were under it, and put it
on a pavement of stone.
18 He removed the covered way for the
Sabbath that they had built in the house,
and the king's outer entrance to Yahweh's
house, because of the king of Assyria.
19 Now the rest of the acts of Ahaz which
he did, aren't they written in the book of
the chronicles of the kings of Judah?
20 Ahaz slept with his fathers, and was
buried with his fathers in David's city;
and Hezekiah his son reigned in his place.

17

1 In the twelfth year of Ahaz king of
Judah, Hoshea the son of Elah began to
reign in Samaria over Israel for nine
years.
2 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's
sight, yet not as the kings of Israel who
were before him.
3 Shalmaneser king of Assyria came up
against him; and Hoshea became his
servant, and brought him tribute.
4 The king of Assyria discovered a
conspiracy in Hoshea; for he had sent
messengers to So king of Egypt, and
offered no tribute to the king of Assyria,
as he had done year by year. Therefore
the king of Assyria seized him, and bound
him in prison.
5 Then the king of Assyria came up
throughout all the land, went up to
Samaria, and besieged it three years.
6 In the ninth year of Hoshea the king of
Assyria took Samaria and carried Israel
away to Assyria, and placed them in
Halah, and on the Habor, the river of
Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes.
7 It was so because the children of Israel
had sinned against Yahweh their God,
who brought them up out of the land of
Egypt from under the hand of Pharaoh
king of Egypt, and had feared other gods,
8 and walked in the statutes of the
nations whom Yahweh cast out from
before the children of Israel, and of the
kings of Israel, which they made.
9 The children of Israel secretly did
things that were not right against Yahweh
their God; and they built high places for
themselves in all their cities, from the
tower of the watchmen to the fortified
city;
10 and they set up for themselves pillars
and Asherah poles on every high hill and
under every green tree;
11 and there they burned incense in all
the high places, as the nations whom
Yahweh carried away before them did;
and they did wicked things to provoke
Yahweh to anger;
12 and they served idols, of which
Yahweh had said to them, "You shall not
do this thing."
13 Yet Yahweh testified to Israel and to
Judah, by every prophet and every seer,
saying, "Turn from your evil ways, and
keep my commandments and my statutes,
according to all the law which I
commanded your fathers, and which I
sent to you by my servants the prophets."
14 Notwithstanding, they would not
listen, but hardened their neck like the
neck of their fathers who didn't believe in
Yahweh their God.
15 They rejected his statutes and his
covenant that he made with their fathers,
and his testimonies which he testified to
them; and they followed vanity, and
became vain, and followed the nations
that were around them, concerning
whom Yahweh had commanded them

that they should not do like them.
16 They abandoned all the
commandments of Yahweh their God, and
made molten images for themselves, even
two calves, and made an Asherah, and
worshiped all the army of the sky, and
served Baal.
17 They caused their sons and their
daughters to pass through the fire, used
divination and enchantments, and sold
themselves to do that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight, to provoke him to anger.
18 Therefore Yahweh was very angry
with Israel, and removed them out of his
sight. There was none left but the tribe of
Judah only.
19 Also Judah didn't keep the
commandments of Yahweh their God, but
walked in the statutes of Israel which they
made.
20 Yahweh rejected all the offspring of
Israel, afflicted them, and delivered them
into the hands of raiders, until he had cast
them out of his sight.
21 For he tore Israel from David's house;
and they made Jeroboam the son of Nebat
king; and Jeroboam drove Israel from
following Yahweh, and made them sin a
great sin.
22 The children of Israel walked in all
the sins of Jeroboam which he did; they
didn't depart from them
23 until Yahweh removed Israel out of
his sight, as he said by all his servants the
prophets. So Israel was carried away out
of their own land to Assyria to this day.
24 The king of Assyria brought people
from Babylon, from Cuthah, from Avva,
and from Hamath and Sepharvaim, and
placed them in the cities of Samaria
instead of the children of Israel; and they
possessed Samaria and lived in its cities.
25 So it was, at the beginning of their
dwelling there, that they didn't fear
Yahweh. Therefore Yahweh sent lions
among them, which killed some of them.
26 Therefore they spoke to the king of
Assyria, saying, "The nations which you
have carried away and placed in the cities
of Samaria don't know the law of the god
of the land. Therefore he has sent lions
among them; and behold, they kill them,
because they don't know the law of the
god of the land."
27 Then the king of Assyria commanded,
saying, "Carry there one of the priests
whom you brought from there; and let
him† go and dwell there, and let him teach
them the law of the god of the land."
28 So one of the priests whom they had
carried away from Samaria came and
lived in Bethel, and taught them how they
should fear Yahweh.
29 However every nation made gods of
their own, and put them in the houses of
the high places which the Samaritans had
made, every nation in their cities in which
they lived.
30 The men of Babylon made Succoth
Benoth, and the men of Cuth made Nergal,
and the men of Hamath made Ashima,
31 and the Avvites made Nibhaz and
Tartak; and the Sepharvites burned their
children in the fire to Adrammelech and
Anammelech, the gods of Sepharvaim.
32 So they feared Yahweh, and also
made from among themselves priests of
the high places for themselves, who
sacrificed for them in the houses of the
high places.
33 They feared Yahweh, and also served
their own gods, after the ways of the
nations from among whom they had been
carried away.
34 To this day they do what they did
before. They don't fear Yahweh, and they
do not follow the statutes, or the
ordinances, or the law, or the
commandment which Yahweh
commanded the children of Jacob, whom
he named Israel;
35 with whom Yahweh had made a
covenant and commanded them, saying,
"You shall not fear other gods, nor bow
yourselves to them, nor serve them, nor
sacrifice to them;
36 but you shall fear Yahweh, who
brought you up out of the land of Egypt
with great power and with an
outstretched arm, and you shall bow

† **17:27** Hebrew: *them*

yourselves to him, and you shall sacrifice to him.
37 The statutes and the ordinances, and the law and the commandment which he wrote for you, you shall observe to do forever more. You shall not fear other gods.
38 You shall not forget the covenant that I have made with you. You shall not fear other gods.
39 But you shall fear Yahweh your God, and he will deliver you out of the hand of all your enemies."
40 However they didn't listen, but they did what they did before.
41 So these nations feared Yahweh, and also served their engraved images. Their children did likewise, and so did their children's children. They do as their fathers did to this day.

18

1 Now in the third year of Hoshea son of Elah king of Israel, Hezekiah the son of Ahaz king of Judah began to reign.
2 He was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Abi the daughter of Zechariah.
3 He did that which was right in Yahweh's eyes, according to all that David his father had done.
4 He removed the high places, broke the pillars, and cut down the Asherah. He also broke in pieces the bronze serpent that Moses had made, because in those days the children of Israel burned incense to it; and he called it Nehushtan.
5 He trusted in Yahweh, the God of Israel, so that after him was no one like him among all the kings of Judah, nor among them that were before him.
6 For he joined with Yahweh. He didn't depart from following him, but kept his commandments, which Yahweh commanded Moses.
7 Yahweh was with him. Wherever he went, he prospered. He rebelled against the king of Assyria, and didn't serve him.
8 He struck the Philistines to Gaza and its borders, from the tower of the watchmen to the fortified city.
9 In the fourth year of King Hezekiah, which was the seventh year of Hoshea son of Elah king of Israel, Shalmaneser king of Assyria came up against Samaria and besieged it.
10 At the end of three years they took it. In the sixth year of Hezekiah, which was the ninth year of Hoshea king of Israel, Samaria was taken.
11 The king of Assyria carried Israel away to Assyria, and put them in Halah, and on the Habor, the river of Gozan, and in the cities of the Medes,
12 because they didn't obey Yahweh their God's voice, but transgressed his covenant, even all that Moses the servant of Yahweh commanded, and would not hear it or do it.
13 Now in the fourteenth year of King Hezekiah, Sennacherib king of Assyria came up against all the fortified cities of Judah and took them.
14 Hezekiah king of Judah sent to the king of Assyria at Lachish, saying, "I have offended you. Withdraw from me. That which you put on me, I will bear." The king of Assyria appointed to Hezekiah king of Judah three hundred talents of silver and thirty talents† of gold.
15 Hezekiah gave him all the silver that was found in Yahweh's house and in the treasures of the king's house.
16 At that time, Hezekiah cut off the gold from the doors of Yahweh's temple, and from the pillars which Hezekiah king of Judah had overlaid, and gave it to the king of Assyria.
17 The king of Assyria sent Tartan, Rabsaris, and Rabshakeh from Lachish to King Hezekiah with a great army to Jerusalem. They went up and came to Jerusalem. When they had come up, they came and stood by the conduit of the upper pool, which is in the highway of the fuller's field.
18 When they had called to the king, Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who was over

† **18:14** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

the household, and Shebnah the scribe, and Joah the son of Asaph the recorder came out to them.
19 Rabshakeh said to them, “Say now to Hezekiah, ‘The great king, the king of Assyria, says, “What confidence is this in which you trust?
20 You say (but they are but vain words), ‘There is counsel and strength for war.’ Now on whom do you trust, that you have rebelled against me?
21 Now, behold, you trust in the staff of this bruised reed, even in Egypt. If a man leans on it, it will go into his hand and pierce it. So is Pharaoh king of Egypt to all who trust on him.
22 But if you tell me, ‘We trust in Yahweh our God,’ isn’t that he whose high places and whose altars Hezekiah has taken away, and has said to Judah and to Jerusalem, ‘You shall worship before this altar in Jerusalem’?
23 Now therefore, please give pledges to my master the king of Assyria, and I will give you two thousand horses if you are able on your part to set riders on them.
24 How then can you turn away the face of one captain of the least of my master’s servants, and put your trust on Egypt for chariots and for horsemen?
25 Have I now come up without Yahweh against this place to destroy it? Yahweh said to me, ‘Go up against this land, and destroy it.’ ” ’ ”
26 Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, Shebnah, and Joah, said to Rabshakeh, “Please speak to your servants in the Syrian language, for we understand it. Don’t speak with us in the Jews’ language, in the hearing of the people who are on the wall.”
27 But Rabshakeh said to them, “Has my master sent me to your master and to you, to speak these words? Hasn’t he sent me to the men who sit on the wall, to eat their own dung, and to drink their own urine with you?”
28 Then Rabshakeh stood and cried with a loud voice in the Jews’ language, and spoke, saying, “Hear the word of the great king, the king of Assyria.
29 The king says, ‘Don’t let Hezekiah deceive you, for he will not be able to deliver you out of his hand.
30 Don’t let Hezekiah make you trust in Yahweh, saying, “Yahweh will surely deliver us, and this city shall not be given into the hand of the king of Assyria.”
31 Don’t listen to Hezekiah.’ For the king of Assyria says, ‘Make your peace with me, and come out to me; and everyone of you eat from his own vine, and everyone from his own fig tree, and everyone drink water from his own cistern;
32 until I come and take you away to a land like your own land, a land of grain and new wine, a land of bread and vineyards, a land of olive trees and of honey, that you may live and not die. Don’t listen to Hezekiah when he persuades you, saying, “Yahweh will deliver us.”
33 Has any of the gods of the nations ever delivered his land out of the hand of the king of Assyria?
34 Where are the gods of Hamath and of Arpad? Where are the gods of Sepharvaim, of Hena, and Ivvah? Have they delivered Samaria out of my hand?
35 Who are they among all the gods of the countries, that have delivered their country out of my hand, that Yahweh should deliver Jerusalem out of my hand?’ ”
36 But the people stayed quiet, and answered him not a word; for the king’s commandment was, “Don’t answer him.”
37 Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who was over the household, came with Shebna the scribe and Joah the son of Asaph the recorder to Hezekiah with their clothes torn, and told him Rabshakeh’s words.

19

1 When King Hezekiah heard it, he tore his clothes, covered himself with sackcloth, and went into Yahweh’s house.
2 He sent Eliakim, who was over the household, Shebna the scribe, and the elders of the priests, covered with sackcloth, to Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz.

3 They said to him, “Hezekiah says,
‘Today is a day of trouble, of rebuke, and
of rejection; for the children have come to
the point of birth, and there is no strength
to deliver them.
4 It may be Yahweh your God will hear
all the words of Rabshakeh, whom the
king of Assyria his master has sent to defy
the living God, and will rebuke the words
which Yahweh your God has heard.
Therefore lift up your prayer for the
remnant that is left.’ ”
5 So the servants of King Hezekiah came
to Isaiah.
6 Isaiah said to them, “Tell your master
this: ‘Yahweh says, “Don’t be afraid of the
words that you have heard, with which
the servants of the king of Assyria have
blasphemed me.
7 Behold, I will put a spirit in him, and
he will hear news, and will return to his
own land. I will cause him to fall by the
sword in his own land.” ’ ”
8 So Rabshakeh returned and found the
king of Assyria warring against Libnah;
for he had heard that he had departed
from Lachish.
9 When he heard it said of Tirhakah
king of Ethiopia, “Behold, he has come out
to fight against you,” he sent messengers
again to Hezekiah, saying,
10 “Tell Hezekiah king of Judah this:
‘Don’t let your God in whom you trust
deceive you, saying, Jerusalem will not be
given into the hand of the king of Assyria.
11 Behold, you have heard what the
kings of Assyria have done to all lands, by
destroying them utterly. Will you be
delivered?
12 Have the gods of the nations
delivered them, which my fathers have
destroyed—Gozan, Haran, Rezeph, and the
children of Eden who were in Telassar?
13 Where is the king of Hamath, the king
of Arpad, and the king of the city of
Sepharvaim, of Hena, and Ivvah?’ ”
14 Hezekiah received the letter from the
hand of the messengers and read it. Then
Hezekiah went up to Yahweh’s house, and
spread it before Yahweh.
15 Hezekiah prayed before Yahweh, and
said, “Yahweh, the God of Israel, who are
enthroned above the cherubim, you are
the God, even you alone, of all the
kingdoms of the earth. You have made
heaven and earth.
16 Incline your ear, Yahweh, and hear.
Open your eyes, Yahweh, and see. Hear
the words of Sennacherib, which he has
sent to defy the living God.
17 Truly, Yahweh, the kings of Assyria
have laid waste the nations and their
lands,
18 and have cast their gods into the fire;
for they were no gods, but the work of
men’s hands, wood and stone. Therefore
they have destroyed them.
19 Now therefore, Yahweh our God, save
us, I beg you, out of his hand, that all the
kingdoms of the earth may know that you,
Yahweh, are God alone.”
20 Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent to
Hezekiah, saying, “Yahweh, the God of
Israel, says ‘You have prayed to me against
Sennacherib king of Assyria, and I have
heard you.
21 This is the word that Yahweh has
spoken concerning him: ‘The virgin
daughter of Zion has despised you and
ridiculed you. The daughter of Jerusalem
has shaken her head at you.
22 Whom have you defied and
blasphemed? Against whom have you
exalted your voice and lifted up your eyes
on high? Against the Holy One of Israel!
23 By your messengers, you have defied
the Lord, and have said, “With the
multitude of my chariots, I have come up
to the height of the mountains, to the
innermost parts of Lebanon, and I will cut
down its tall cedars and its choice cypress
trees; and I will enter into his farthest
lodging place, the forest of his fruitful
field.
24 I have dug and drunk strange waters,
and I will dry up all the rivers of Egypt
with the sole of my feet.”
25 Haven’t you heard how I have done it
long ago, and formed it of ancient times?
Now I have brought it to pass, that it
should be yours to lay waste fortified
cities into ruinous heaps.
26 Therefore their inhabitants had little
power. They were dismayed and

confounded. They were like the grass of
the field and like the green herb, like the
grass on the housetops and like grain
blasted before it has grown up.
27 But I know your sitting down, your
going out, your coming in, and your
raging against me.
28 Because of your raging against me,
and because your arrogance has come up
into my ears, therefore I will put my hook
in your nose, and my bridle in your lips,
and I will turn you back by the way by
which you came.'
29 "This will be the sign to you: This
year, you will eat that which grows of
itself, and in the second year that which
springs from that; and in the third year
sow and reap, and plant vineyards and
eat their fruit.
30 The remnant that has escaped of the
house of Judah will again take root
downward, and bear fruit upward.
31 For out of Jerusalem a remnant will
go out, and out of Mount Zion those who
shall escape. Yahweh's zeal will perform
this.
32 "Therefore Yahweh says concerning
the king of Assyria, 'He will not come to
this city, nor shoot an arrow there. He will
not come before it with shield, nor cast up
a mound against it.
33 He will return the same way that he
came, and he will not come to this city,'
says Yahweh.
34 'For I will defend this city to save it,
for my own sake and for my servant
David's sake.' "
35 That night, Yahweh's angel went out
and struck one hundred eighty-five
thousand in the camp of the Assyrians.
When men arose early in the morning,
behold, these were all dead bodies.
36 So Sennacherib king of Assyria
departed, went home, and lived at
Nineveh.
37 As he was worshiping in the house of
Nisroch his god, Adrammelech and
Sharezer struck him with the sword; and
they escaped into the land of Ararat. Esar
Haddon his son reigned in his place.

20

1 In those days Hezekiah was sick and
dying. Isaiah the prophet the son of Amoz
came to him, and said to him, "Yahweh
says, 'Set your house in order; for you will
die, and not live.' "
2 Then he turned his face to the wall,
and prayed to Yahweh, saying,
3 "Remember now, Yahweh, I beg you,
how I have walked before you in truth
and with a perfect heart, and have done
that which is good in your sight." And
Hezekiah wept bitterly.
4 Before Isaiah had gone out into the
middle part of the city, Yahweh's word
came to him, saying,
5 "Turn back, and tell Hezekiah the
prince of my people, 'Yahweh, the God of
David your father, says, "I have heard
your prayer. I have seen your tears.
Behold, I will heal you. On the third day,
you will go up to Yahweh's house.
6 I will add to your days fifteen years. I
will deliver you and this city out of the
hand of the king of Assyria. I will defend
this city for my own sake, and for my
servant David's sake." ' "
7 Isaiah said, "Take a cake of figs."
They took and laid it on the boil, and he
recovered.
8 Hezekiah said to Isaiah, "What will be
the sign that Yahweh will heal me, and
that I will go up to Yahweh's house the
third day?"
9 Isaiah said, "This will be the sign to
you from Yahweh, that Yahweh will do the
thing that he has spoken: should the
shadow go forward ten steps, or go back
ten steps?"
10 Hezekiah answered, "It is a light thing
for the shadow to go forward ten steps.
No, but let the shadow return backward
ten steps."
11 Isaiah the prophet cried to Yahweh;
and he brought the shadow ten steps
backward, by which it had gone down on
the sundial of Ahaz.
12 At that time Berodach Baladan the
son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent
letters and a present to Hezekiah, for he
had heard that Hezekiah had been sick.

13 Hezekiah listened to them, and showed them all the storehouse of his precious things—the silver, the gold, the spices, and the precious oil, and the house of his armor, and all that was found in his treasures. There was nothing in his house, or in all his dominion, that Hezekiah didn't show them.
14 Then Isaiah the prophet came to King Hezekiah, and said to him, "What did these men say? From where did they come to you?"

Hezekiah said, "They have come from a far country, even from Babylon."
15 He said, "What have they seen in your house?"

Hezekiah answered, "They have seen all that is in my house. There is nothing among my treasures that I have not shown them."
16 Isaiah said to Hezekiah, "Hear Yahweh's word.
17 'Behold, the days come that all that is in your house, and that which your fathers have laid up in store to this day, will be carried to Babylon. Nothing will be left,' says Yahweh.
18 'They will take away some of your sons who will issue from you, whom you will father; and they will be eunuchs in the palace of the king of Babylon.' "
19 Then Hezekiah said to Isaiah, "Yahweh's word which you have spoken is good." He said moreover, "Isn't it so, if peace and truth will be in my days?"
20 Now the rest of the acts of Hezekiah, and all his might, and how he made the pool, and the conduit, and brought water into the city, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?
21 Hezekiah slept with his fathers, and Manasseh his son reigned in his place.

21

1 Manasseh was twelve years old when he began to reign, and he reigned fifty-five years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hephzibah.
2 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, after the abominations of the nations whom Yahweh cast out before the children of Israel.
3 For he built again the high places which Hezekiah his father had destroyed; and he raised up altars for Baal, and made an Asherah, as Ahab king of Israel did, and worshiped all the army of the sky, and served them.
4 He built altars in Yahweh's house, of which Yahweh said, "I will put my name in Jerusalem."
5 He built altars for all the army of the sky in the two courts of Yahweh's house.
6 He made his son to pass through the fire, practiced sorcery, used enchantments, and dealt with those who had familiar spirits and with wizards. He did much evil in Yahweh's sight, to provoke him to anger.
7 He set the engraved image of Asherah that he had made in the house of which Yahweh said to David and to Solomon his son, "In this house, and in Jerusalem, which I have chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, I will put my name forever;
8 I will not cause the feet of Israel to wander any more out of the land which I gave their fathers, if only they will observe to do according to all that I have commanded them, and according to all the law that my servant Moses commanded them."
9 But they didn't listen, and Manasseh seduced them to do that which is evil more than the nations did whom Yahweh destroyed before the children of Israel.

10 Yahweh spoke by his servants the prophets, saying,
11 "Because Manasseh king of Judah has done these abominations, and has done wickedly above all that the Amorites did, who were before him, and has also made Judah to sin with his idols;
12 therefore Yahweh the God of Israel says, 'Behold, I will bring such evil on Jerusalem and Judah that whoever hears of it, both his ears will tingle.
13 I will stretch over Jerusalem the line of Samaria, and the plumb line of Ahab's house; and I will wipe Jerusalem as a man wipes a dish, wiping it and turning it upside down.

14 I will cast off the remnant of my
inheritance and deliver them into the
hands of their enemies. They will become
a prey and a plunder to all their enemies,
15 because they have done that which is
evil in my sight, and have provoked me to
anger since the day their fathers came out
of Egypt, even to this day.' "

16 Moreover Manasseh shed innocent
blood very much, until he had filled
Jerusalem from one end to another; in
addition to his sin with which he made
Judah to sin, in doing that which was evil
in Yahweh's sight.

17 Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh,
and all that he did, and his sin that he
sinned, aren't they written in the book of
the chronicles of the kings of Judah?
18 Manasseh slept with his fathers, and
was buried in the garden of his own
house, in the garden of Uzza; and Amon
his son reigned in his place.

19 Amon was twenty-two years old
when he began to reign; and he reigned
two years in Jerusalem. His mother's
name was Meshullemeth the daughter of
Haruz of Jotbah.
20 He did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight, as Manasseh his father
did.
21 He walked in all the ways that his
father walked in, and served the idols that
his father served, and worshiped them;
22 and he abandoned Yahweh, the God
of his fathers, and didn't walk in the way
of Yahweh.
23 The servants of Amon conspired
against him, and put the king to death in
his own house.
24 But the people of the land killed all
those who had conspired against King
Amon; and the people of the land made
Josiah his son king in his place.
25 Now the rest of the acts of Amon
which he did, aren't they written in the
book of the chronicles of the kings of
Judah?
26 He was buried in his tomb in the
garden of Uzza, and Josiah his son reigned
in his place.

22

1 Josiah was eight years old when he
began to reign, and he reigned thirty-one
years in Jerusalem. His mother's name
was Jedidah the daughter of Adaiah of
Bozkath.
2 He did that which was right in
Yahweh's eyes, and walked in all the ways
of David his father, and didn't turn away
to the right hand or to the left.

3 In the eighteenth year of King Josiah,
the king sent Shaphan, the son of Azaliah
the son of Meshullam, the scribe, to
Yahweh's house, saying,
4 "Go up to Hilkiah the high priest, that
he may count the money which is brought
into Yahweh's house, which the keepers of
the threshold have gathered of the people.
5 Let them deliver it into the hand of the
workers who have the oversight of
Yahweh's house; and let them give it to the
workers who are in Yahweh's house, to
repair the damage to the house,
6 to the carpenters, and to the builders,
and to the masons, and for buying timber
and cut stone to repair the house.
7 However, no accounting shall be asked
of them for the money delivered into their
hand, for they deal faithfully."

8 Hilkiah the high priest said to Shaphan
the scribe, "I have found the book of the
law in Yahweh's house." Hilkiah delivered
the book to Shaphan, and he read it.
9 Shaphan the scribe came to the king,
and brought the king word again, and
said, "Your servants have emptied out the
money that was found in the house, and
have delivered it into the hands of the
workmen who have the oversight of
Yahweh's house."
10 Shaphan the scribe told the king,
saying, "Hilkiah the priest has delivered a
book to me." Then Shaphan read it before
the king.

11 When the king had heard the words
of the book of the law, he tore his clothes.
12 The king commanded Hilkiah the
priest, Ahikam the son of Shaphan,
Achbor the son of Micaiah, Shaphan the
scribe, and Asaiah the king's servant,
saying,

13 “Go inquire of Yahweh for me, and for
the people, and for all Judah, concerning
the words of this book that is found; for
great is Yahweh’s wrath that is kindled
against us, because our fathers have not
listened to the words of this book, to do
according to all that which is written
concerning us.”
14 So Hilkiah the priest, Ahikam,
Achbor, Shaphan, and Asaiah went to
Huldah the prophetess, the wife of
Shallum the son of Tikvah, the son of
Harhas, keeper of the wardrobe (now she
lived in Jerusalem in the second quarter);
and they talked with her.
15 She said to them, “Yahweh the God of
Israel says, ‘Tell the man who sent you to
me,
16 “Yahweh says, ‘Behold, I will bring
evil on this place and on its inhabitants,
even all the words of the book which the
king of Judah has read.
17 Because they have forsaken me and
have burned incense to other gods, that
they might provoke me to anger with all
the work of their hands, therefore my
wrath shall be kindled against this place,
and it will not be quenched.’ ”
18 But to the king of Judah, who sent you
to inquire of Yahweh, tell him, “Yahweh
the God of Israel says, ‘Concerning the
words which you have heard,
19 because your heart was tender, and
you humbled yourself before Yahweh
when you heard what I spoke against this
place and against its inhabitants, that they
should become a desolation and a curse,
and have torn your clothes and wept
before me, I also have heard you,’ says
Yahweh.
20 ‘Therefore behold, I will gather you to
your fathers, and you will be gathered to
your grave in peace. Your eyes will not see
all the evil which I will bring on this
place.’ ” ’ ” So they brought this message
back to the king.

23

1 The king sent, and they gathered to
him all the elders of Judah and of
Jerusalem.
2 The king went up to Yahweh’s house,
and all the men of Judah and all the
inhabitants of Jerusalem with him—with
the priests, the prophets, and all the
people, both small and great; and he read
in their hearing all the words of the book
of the covenant which was found in
Yahweh’s house.
3 The king stood by the pillar and made
a covenant before Yahweh to walk after
Yahweh and to keep his commandments,
his testimonies, and his statutes with all
his heart and all his soul, to confirm the
words of this covenant that were written
in this book; and all the people agreed to
the covenant.
4 The king commanded Hilkiah the high
priest, and the priests of the second order,
and the keepers of the threshold, to bring
out of Yahweh’s temple all the vessels that
were made for Baal, for the Asherah, and
for all the army of the sky; and he burned
them outside of Jerusalem in the fields of
the Kidron, and carried their ashes to
Bethel.
5 He got rid of the idolatrous priests
whom the kings of Judah had ordained to
burn incense in the high places in the
cities of Judah and in the places around
Jerusalem; those also who burned incense
to Baal, to the sun, to the moon, to the
planets, and to all the army of the sky.
6 He brought out the Asherah from
Yahweh’s house, outside of Jerusalem, to
the brook Kidron, and burned it at the
brook Kidron, and beat it to dust, and cast
its dust on the graves of the common
people.
7 He broke down the houses of the male
shrine prostitutes that were in Yahweh’s
house, where the women wove hangings
for the Asherah.
8 He brought all the priests out of the
cities of Judah, and defiled the high places
where the priests had burned incense,
from Geba to Beersheba; and he broke
down the high places of the gates that
were at the entrance of the gate of Joshua
the governor of the city, which were on a
man’s left hand at the gate of the city.
9 Nevertheless the priests of the high
places didn’t come up to Yahweh’s altar in

Jerusalem, but they ate unleavened bread among their brothers.
10 He defiled Topheth, which is in the valley of the children of Hinnom, that no man might make his son or his daughter to pass through the fire to Molech.
11 He took away the horses that the kings of Judah had dedicated to the sun, at the entrance of Yahweh's house, by the room of Nathan Melech the officer who was in the court; and he burned the chariots of the sun with fire.
12 The king broke down the altars that were on the roof of the upper room of Ahaz, which the kings of Judah had made, and the altars which Manasseh had made in the two courts of Yahweh's house, and beat them down from there, and cast their dust into the brook Kidron.
13 The king defiled the high places that were before Jerusalem, which were on the right hand of the mountain of corruption, which Solomon the king of Israel had built for Ashtoreth the abomination of the Sidonians, and for Chemosh the abomination of Moab, and for Milcom the abomination of the children of Ammon.
14 He broke in pieces the pillars, cut down the Asherah poles, and filled their places with men's bones.
15 Moreover the altar that was at Bethel and the high place which Jeroboam the son of Nebat, who made Israel to sin, had made, even that altar and the high place he broke down; and he burned the high place and beat it to dust, and burned the Asherah.
16 As Josiah turned himself, he spied the tombs that were there in the mountain; and he sent, and took the bones out of the tombs, and burned them on the altar, and defiled it, according to Yahweh's word which the man of God proclaimed, who proclaimed these things.
17 Then he said, "What monument is that which I see?"
The men of the city told him, "It is the tomb of the man of God who came from Judah and proclaimed these things that you have done against the altar of Bethel."
18 He said, "Let him be! Let no one move his bones." So they let his bones alone, with the bones of the prophet who came out of Samaria.
19 All the houses also of the high places that were in the cities of Samaria, which the kings of Israel had made to provoke Yahweh to anger, Josiah took away, and did to them according to all the acts that he had done in Bethel.
20 He killed all the priests of the high places that were there, on the altars, and burned men's bones on them; and he returned to Jerusalem.

21 The king commanded all the people, saying, "Keep the Passover to Yahweh your God, as it is written in this book of the covenant."
22 Surely there was not kept such a Passover from the days of the judges who judged Israel, nor in all the days of the kings of Israel, nor of the kings of Judah;
23 but in the eighteenth year of King Josiah, this Passover was kept to Yahweh in Jerusalem.

24 Moreover, Josiah removed those who had familiar spirits, the wizards, and the teraphim,† and the idols, and all the abominations that were seen in the land of Judah and in Jerusalem, that he might confirm the words of the law which were written in the book that Hilkiah the priest found in Yahweh's house.
25 There was no king like him before him, who turned to Yahweh with all his heart, and with all his soul, and with all his might, according to all the law of Moses; and there was none like him who arose after him.
26 Notwithstanding, Yahweh didn't turn from the fierceness of his great wrath, with which his anger burned against Judah, because of all the provocation with which Manasseh had provoked him.
27 Yahweh said, "I will also remove Judah out of my sight, as I have removed Israel; and I will cast off this city which I have chosen, even Jerusalem, and the house of which I said, 'My name shall be there.' "

28 Now the rest of the acts of Josiah, and all that he did, aren't they written in the

† **23:24** teraphim were household idols.

book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?
29 In his days Pharaoh Necoh king of Egypt went up against the king of Assyria to the river Euphrates; and King Josiah went against him, but Pharaoh Necoh killed him at Megiddo when he saw him.
30 His servants carried him dead in a chariot from Megiddo, brought him to Jerusalem, and buried him in his own tomb. The people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah, and anointed him, and made him king in his father's place.
31 Jehoahaz was twenty-three years old when he began to reign; and he reigned three months in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.
32 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, according to all that his fathers had done.
33 Pharaoh Necoh put him in bonds at Riblah in the land of Hamath, that he might not reign in Jerusalem; and put the land to a tribute of one hundred talents of silver and a talent‡ of gold.
34 Pharaoh Necoh made Eliakim the son of Josiah king in the place of Josiah his father, and changed his name to Jehoiakim; but he took Jehoahaz away, and he came to Egypt and died there.
35 Jehoiakim gave the silver and the gold to Pharaoh; but he taxed the land to give the money according to the commandment of Pharaoh. He exacted the silver and the gold of the people of the land, from everyone according to his assessment, to give it to Pharaoh Necoh.
36 Jehoiakim was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Zebidah the daughter of Pedaiah of Rumah.
37 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, according to all that his fathers had done.

24

1 In his days Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up, and Jehoiakim became his servant three years. Then he turned and rebelled against him.
2 Yahweh sent against him bands of the Chaldeans, bands of the Syrians, bands of the Moabites, and bands of the children of Ammon, and sent them against Judah to destroy it, according to Yahweh's word which he spoke by his servants the prophets.
3 Surely at the commandment of Yahweh this came on Judah, to remove them out of his sight for the sins of Manasseh, according to all that he did,
4 and also for the innocent blood that he shed; for he filled Jerusalem with innocent blood, and Yahweh would not pardon.
5 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, and all that he did, aren't they written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Judah?
6 So Jehoiakim slept with his fathers, and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his place.
7 The king of Egypt didn't come out of his land any more; for the king of Babylon had taken, from the brook of Egypt to the river Euphrates, all that belonged to the king of Egypt.
8 Jehoiachin was eighteen years old when he began to reign, and he reigned in Jerusalem three months. His mother's name was Nehushta the daughter of Elnathan of Jerusalem.
9 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, according to all that his father had done.
10 At that time the servants of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up to Jerusalem, and the city was besieged.
11 Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came to the city while his servants were besieging it,
12 and Jehoiachin the king of Judah went out to the king of Babylon—he, his mother, his servants, his princes, and his officers; and the king of Babylon captured him in the eighth year of his reign.
13 He carried out from there all the treasures of Yahweh's house and the

‡ **23:33** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

treasures of the king's house, and cut in pieces all the vessels of gold which Solomon king of Israel had made in Yahweh's temple, as Yahweh had said.
14 He carried away all Jerusalem, and all the princes, and all the mighty men of valor, even ten thousand captives, and all the craftsmen and the smiths. No one remained except the poorest people of the land.
15 He carried away Jehoiachin to Babylon, with the king's mother, the king's wives, his officers, and the chief men of the land. He carried them into captivity from Jerusalem to Babylon.
16 All the men of might, even seven thousand, and the craftsmen and the smiths one thousand, all of them strong and fit for war, even them the king of Babylon brought captive to Babylon.
17 The king of Babylon made Mattaniah, Jehoiachin's father's brother, king in his place, and changed his name to Zedekiah.
18 Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.
19 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, according to all that Jehoiakim had done.
20 For through the anger of Yahweh, this happened in Jerusalem and Judah, until he had cast them out from his presence.

Then Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon.

25

1 In the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came, he and all his army, against Jerusalem, and encamped against it; and they built forts against it around it.
2 So the city was besieged until the eleventh year of King Zedekiah.
3 On the ninth day of the fourth month, the famine was severe in the city, so that there was no bread for the people of the land.
4 Then a breach was made in the city, and all the men of war fled by night by the way of the gate between the two walls, which was by the king's garden (now the Chaldeans were against the city around it); and the king went by the way of the Arabah.
5 But the Chaldean army pursued the king, and overtook him in the plains of Jericho; and all his army was scattered from him.
6 Then they captured the king and carried him up to the king of Babylon to Riblah; and they passed judgment on him.
7 They killed Zedekiah's sons before his eyes, then put out Zedekiah's eyes, bound him in fetters, and carried him to Babylon.
8 Now in the fifth month, on the seventh day of the month, which was the nineteenth year of King Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard, a servant of the king of Babylon, came to Jerusalem.
9 He burned Yahweh's house, the king's house, and all the houses of Jerusalem. He burned every great house with fire.
10 All the army of the Chaldeans, who were with the captain of the guard, broke down the walls around Jerusalem.
11 Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard carried away captive the rest of the people who were left in the city and those who had deserted to the king of Babylon—all the rest of the multitude.
12 But the captain of the guard left some of the poorest of the land to work the vineyards and fields.
13 The Chaldeans broke up the pillars of bronze that were in Yahweh's house and the bases and the bronze sea that were in Yahweh's house, and carried the bronze pieces to Babylon.
14 They took away the pots, the shovels, the snuffers, the spoons, and all the vessels of bronze with which they ministered.
15 The captain of the guard took away the fire pans, the basins, that which was of gold, for gold, and that which was of silver, for silver.

16 The two pillars, the one sea, and the
bases, which Solomon had made for
Yahweh's house, the bronze of all these
vessels was not weighed.
17 The height of the one pillar was
eighteen cubits,† and a capital of bronze
was on it. The height of the capital was
three cubits, with network and
pomegranates on the capital around it, all
of bronze; and the second pillar with its
network was like these.
18 The captain of the guard took Seraiah
the chief priest, Zephaniah the second
priest, and the three keepers of the
threshold;
19 and out of the city he took an officer
who was set over the men of war; and five
men of those who saw the king's face, who
were found in the city; and the scribe, the
captain of the army, who mustered the
people of the land, and sixty men of the
people of the land who were found in the
city.
20 Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard
took them, and brought them to the king
of Babylon to Riblah.
21 The king of Babylon attacked them
and put them to death at Riblah in the
land of Hamath. So Judah was carried
away captive out of his land.
22 As for the people who were left in the
land of Judah whom Nebuchadnezzar
king of Babylon had left, even over them
he made Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the
son of Shaphan, governor.
23 Now when all the captains of the
forces, they and their men, heard that the
king of Babylon had made Gedaliah
governor, they came to Gedaliah to
Mizpah, even Ishmael the son of
Nethaniah, Johanan the son of Kareah,
Seraiah the son of Tanhumeth the
Netophathite, and Jaazaniah the son of
the Maacathite, they and their men.
24 Gedaliah swore to them and to their
men, and said to them, "Don't be afraid
because of the servants of the Chaldeans.
Dwell in the land and serve the king of
Babylon, and it will be well with you."
25 But in the seventh month, Ishmael the
son of Nethaniah, the son of Elishama, of
the royal offspring came, and ten men
with him, and struck Gedaliah so that he
died, with the Jews and the Chaldeans that
were with him at Mizpah.
26 All the people, both small and great,
and the captains of the forces arose and
came to Egypt; for they were afraid of the
Chaldeans.
27 In the thirty-seventh year of the
captivity of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in
the twelfth month, on the twenty-seventh
day of the month, Evilmerodach king of
Babylon, in the year that he began to
reign, released Jehoiachin king of Judah
out of prison,
28 and he spoke kindly to him and set his
throne above the throne of the kings who
were with him in Babylon,
29 and changed his prison garments.
Jehoiachin ate bread before him
continually all the days of his life;
30 and for his allowance, there was a
continual allowance given him from the
king, every day a portion, all the days of
his life.

† **25:17** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

The First Book of Chronicles

1 Adam, Seth, Enosh,
2 Kenan, Mahalalel, Jared,
3 Enoch, Methuselah, Lamech,
4 Noah, Shem, Ham, and Japheth.
5 The sons of Japheth: Gomer, Magog, Madai, Javan, Tubal, Meshech, and Tiras.
6 The sons of Gomer: Ashkenaz, Diphath, and Togarmah.
7 The sons of Javan: Elishah, Tarshish, Kittim, and Rodanim.
8 The sons of Ham: Cush, Mizraim, Put, and Canaan.
9 The sons of Cush: Seba, Havilah, Sabta, Raama, Sabteca. The sons of Raamah: Sheba and Dedan.
10 Cush became the father of Nimrod. He began to be a mighty one in the earth.
11 Mizraim became the father of Ludim, Anamim, Lehabim, Naphtuhim,
12 Pathrusim, Casluhim (where the Philistines came from), and Caphtorim.
13 Canaan became the father of Sidon his firstborn, Heth,
14 the Jebusite, the Amorite, the Girgashite,
15 the Hivite, the Arkite, the Sinite,
16 the Arvadite, the Zemarite, and the Hamathite.
17 The sons of Shem: Elam, Asshur, Arpachshad, Lud, Aram, Uz, Hul, Gether, and Meshech.
18 Arpachshad became the father of Shelah, and Shelah became the father of Eber.
19 To Eber were born two sons: the name of the one was Peleg, for in his days the earth was divided; and his brother's name was Joktan.
20 Joktan became the father of Almodad, Sheleph, Hazarmaveth, Jerah,
21 Hadoram, Uzal, Diklah,
22 Ebal, Abimael, Sheba,
23 Ophir, Havilah, and Jobab. All these were the sons of Joktan.
24 Shem, Arpachshad, Shelah,
25 Eber, Peleg, Reu,
26 Serug, Nahor, Terah,
27 Abram (also called Abraham).
28 The sons of Abraham: Isaac and Ishmael.
29 These are their generations: the firstborn of Ishmael, Nebaioth; then Kedar, Adbeel, Mibsam,
30 Mishma, Dumah, Massa, Hadad, Tema,
31 Jetur, Naphish, and Kedemah. These are the sons of Ishmael.
32 The sons of Keturah, Abraham's concubine: she bore Zimran, Jokshan, Medan, Midian, Ishbak, and Shuah. The sons of Jokshan: Sheba and Dedan.
33 The sons of Midian: Ephah, Epher, Hanoch, Abida, and Eldaah. All these were the sons of Keturah.
34 Abraham became the father of Isaac. The sons of Isaac: Esau and Israel.
35 The sons of Esau: Eliphaz, Reuel, Jeush, Jalam, and Korah.
36 The sons of Eliphaz: Teman, Omar, Zephi, Gatam, Kenaz, Timna, and Amalek.
37 The sons of Reuel: Nahath, Zerah, Shammah, and Mizzah.
38 The sons of Seir: Lotan, Shobal, Zibeon, Anah, Dishon, Ezer, and Dishan.
39 The sons of Lotan: Hori and Homam; and Timna was Lotan's sister.
40 The sons of Shobal: Alian, Manahath, Ebal, Shephi, and Onam. The sons of Zibeon: Aiah and Anah.
41 The son of Anah: Dishon. The sons of Dishon: Hamran, Eshban, Ithran, and Cheran.
42 The sons of Ezer: Bilhan, Zaavan, and Jaakan. The sons of Dishan: Uz and Aran.
43 Now these are the kings who reigned in the land of Edom, before any king reigned over the children of Israel: Bela the son of Beor; and the name of his city was Dinhabah.
44 Bela died, and Jobab the son of Zerah of Bozrah reigned in his place.
45 Jobab died, and Husham of the land of the Temanites reigned in his place.
46 Husham died, and Hadad the son of Bedad, who struck Midian in the field of Moab, reigned in his place; and the name of his city was Avith.
47 Hadad died, and Samlah of Masrekah reigned in his place.
48 Samlah died, and Shaul of Rehoboth by the River reigned in his place.

49 Shaul died, and Baal Hanan the son of
Achbor reigned in his place.
50 Baal Hanan died, and Hadad reigned
in his place; and the name of his city was
Pai. His wife's name was Mehetabel, the
daughter of Matred, the daughter of
Mezahab.
51 Then Hadad died. The chiefs of Edom
were: chief Timna, chief Aliah, chief
Jetheth,
52 chief Oholibamah, chief Elah, chief
Pinon,
53 chief Kenaz, chief Teman, chief
Mibzar,
54 chief Magdiel, and chief Iram. These
are the chiefs of Edom.

2

1 These are the sons of Israel: Reuben,
Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun,
2 Dan, Joseph, Benjamin, Naphtali, Gad,
and Asher.
3 The sons of Judah: Er, Onan, and
Shelah, which three were born to him of
Shua's daughter the Canaanitess. Er,
Judah's firstborn, was wicked in
Yahweh's† sight; and he killed him.
4 Tamar his daughter-in-law bore him
Perez and Zerah. All the sons of Judah
were five.
5 The sons of Perez: Hezron and Hamul.
6 The sons of Zerah: Zimri, Ethan,
Heman, Calcol, and Dara—five of them in
all.
7 The son of Carmi: Achar, the troubler
of Israel, who committed a trespass in the
devoted thing.
8 The son of Ethan: Azariah.
9 The sons also of Hezron, who were
born to him: Jerahmeel, Ram, and
Chelubai.
10 Ram became the father of
Amminadab, and Amminadab became
the father of Nahshon, prince of the
children of Judah;
11 and Nahshon became the father of
Salma, and Salma became the father of
Boaz,
12 and Boaz became the father of Obed,
and Obed became the father of Jesse;
13 and Jesse became the father of his
firstborn Eliab, Abinadab the second,
Shimea the third,
14 Nethanel the fourth, Raddai the fifth,
15 Ozem the sixth, and David the
seventh;
16 and their sisters were Zeruiah and
Abigail. The sons of Zeruiah: Abishai,
Joab, and Asahel, three.
17 Abigail bore Amasa; and the father of
Amasa was Jether the Ishmaelite.
18 Caleb the son of Hezron became the
father of children by Azubah his wife, and
by Jerioth; and these were her sons:
Jesher, Shobab, and Ardon.
19 Azubah died, and Caleb married
Ephrath, who bore him Hur.
20 Hur became the father of Uri, and Uri
became the father of Bezalel.
21 Afterward Hezron went in to the
daughter of Machir the father of Gilead,
whom he took as wife when he was sixty
years old; and she bore him Segub.
22 Segub became the father of Jair, who
had twenty-three cities in the land of
Gilead.
23 Geshur and Aram took the towns of
Jair from them, with Kenath, and its
villages, even sixty cities. All these were
the sons of Machir the father of Gilead.
24 After Hezron died in Caleb
Ephrathah, Abijah, Hezron's wife, bore
him Ashhur the father of Tekoa.
25 The sons of Jerahmeel the firstborn of
Hezron were Ram the firstborn, Bunah,
Oren, Ozem, and Ahijah.
26 Jerahmeel had another wife, whose
name was Atarah. She was the mother of
Onam.
27 The sons of Ram the firstborn of
Jerahmeel were Maaz, Jamin, and Eker.
28 The sons of Onam were Shammai and
Jada. The sons of Shammai: Nadab and
Abishur.
29 The name of the wife of Abishur was
Abihail; and she bore him Ahban and
Molid.
30 The sons of Nadab: Seled and
Appaim; but Seled died without children.
31 The son of Appaim: Ishi. The son of
Ishi: Sheshan. The son of Sheshan: Ahlai.

† **2:3** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations.

32 The sons of Jada the brother of
Shammai: Jether and Jonathan; and
Jether died without children.
33 The sons of Jonathan: Peleth and
Zaza. These were the sons of Jerahmeel.
34 Now Sheshan had no sons, but only
daughters. Sheshan had a servant, an
Egyptian, whose name was Jarha.
35 Sheshan gave his daughter to Jarha
his servant as wife; and she bore him
Attai.
36 Attai became the father of Nathan,
and Nathan became the father of Zabad,
37 and Zabad became the father of
Ephlal, and Ephlal became the father of
Obed,
38 and Obed became the father of Jehu,
and Jehu became the father of Azariah,
39 and Azariah became the father of
Helez, and Helez became the father of
Eleasah,
40 and Eleasah became the father of
Sismai, and Sismai became the father of
Shallum,
41 and Shallum became the father of
Jekamiah, and Jekamiah became the
father of Elishama.

42 The sons of Caleb the brother of
Jerahmeel were Mesha his firstborn, who
was the father of Ziph, and the sons of
Mareshah the father of Hebron.
43 The sons of Hebron: Korah, Tappuah,
Rekem, and Shema.
44 Shema became the father of Raham,
the father of Jorkeam; and Rekem became
the father of Shammai.
45 The son of Shammai was Maon; and
Maon was the father of Beth Zur.
46 Ephah, Caleb's concubine, bore
Haran, Moza, and Gazez; and Haran
became the father of Gazez.
47 The sons of Jahdai: Regem, Jothan,
Geshan, Pelet, Ephah, and Shaaph.
48 Maacah, Caleb's concubine, bore
Sheber and Tirhanah.
49 She bore also Shaaph the father of
Madmannah, Sheva the father of
Machbena and the father of Gibea; and
the daughter of Caleb was Achsah.

50 These were the sons of Caleb, the son
of Hur, the firstborn of Ephrathah: Shobal
the father of Kiriath Jearim,
51 Salma the father of Bethlehem, and
Hareph the father of Beth Gader.
52 Shobal the father of Kiriath Jearim
had sons: Haroeh, half of the Menuhoth.
53 The families of Kiriath Jearim: the
Ithrites, the Puthites, the Shumathites,
and the Mishraites; from them came the
Zorathites and the Eshtaolites.
54 The sons of Salma: Bethlehem, the
Netophathites, Atroth Beth Joab, and half
of the Manahathites, the Zorites.
55 The families of scribes who lived at
Jabez: the Tirathites, the Shimeathites,
and the Sucathites. These are the Kenites
who came from Hammath, the father of
the house of Rechab.

3

1 Now these were the sons of David, who
were born to him in Hebron: the
firstborn, Amnon, of Ahinoam the
Jezreelitess; the second, Daniel, of Abigail
the Carmelitess;
2 the third, Absalom the son of Maacah
the daughter of Talmai king of Geshur; the
fourth, Adonijah the son of Haggith;
3 the fifth, Shephatiah of Abital; the
sixth, Ithream by Eglah his wife:
4 six were born to him in Hebron; and
he reigned there seven years and six
months. He reigned thirty-three years in
Jerusalem;
5 and these were born to him in
Jerusalem: Shimea, Shobab, Nathan, and
Solomon, four, by Bathshua the daughter
of Ammiel;
6 and Ibhar, Elishama, Eliphelet,
7 Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia,
8 Elishama, Eliada, and Eliphelet, nine.
9 All these were the sons of David, in
addition to the sons of the concubines;
and Tamar was their sister.
10 Solomon's son was Rehoboam, Abijah
his son, Asa his son, Jehoshaphat his son,
11 Joram his son, Ahaziah his son, Joash
his son,
12 Amaziah his son, Azariah his son,
Jotham his son,
13 Ahaz his son, Hezekiah his son,
Manasseh his son,
14 Amon his son, and Josiah his son.

15 The sons of Josiah: the firstborn
Johanan, the second Jehoiakim, the third
Zedekiah, and the fourth Shallum.
16 The sons of Jehoiakim: Jeconiah his
son, and Zedekiah his son.
17 The sons of Jeconiah, the captive:
Shealtiel his son,
18 Malchiram, Pedaiah, Shenazzar,
Jekamiah, Hoshama, and Nedabiah.
19 The sons of Pedaiah: Zerubbabel and
Shimei. The sons of Zerubbabel:
Meshullam and Hananiah; and Shelomith
was their sister;
20 and Hashubah, Ohel, Berechiah,
Hasadiah, and Jushab Hesed, five.
21 The sons of Hananiah: Pelatiah and
Jeshaiah; the sons of Rephaiah, the sons of
Arnan, the sons of Obadiah, the sons of
Shecaniah.
22 The son of Shecaniah: Shemaiah. The
sons of Shemaiah: Hattush, Igal, Bariah,
Neariah, and Shaphat, six.
23 The sons of Neariah: Elioenai,
Hizkiah, and Azrikam, three.
24 The sons of Elioenai: Hodaviah,
Eliashib, Pelaiah, Akkub, Johanan,
Delaiah, and Anani, seven.

4

1 The sons of Judah: Perez, Hezron,
Carmi, Hur, and Shobal.
2 Reaiah the son of Shobal became the
father of Jahath; and Jahath became the
father of Ahumai and Lahad. These are
the families of the Zorathites.
3 These were the sons of the father of
Etam: Jezreel, Ishma, and Idbash. The
name of their sister was Hazzelelponi.
4 Penuel was the father of Gedor and
Ezer the father of Hushah. These are the
sons of Hur, the firstborn of Ephrathah,
the father of Bethlehem.
5 Ashhur the father of Tekoa had two
wives, Helah and Naarah.
6 Naarah bore him Ahuzzam, Hepher,
Temeni, and Haahashtari. These were the
sons of Naarah.
7 The sons of Helah were Zereth, Izhar,
and Ethnan.
8 Hakkoz became the father of Anub,
Zobebah, and the families of Aharhel the
son of Harum.
9 Jabez was more honorable than his
brothers. His mother named him Jabez,†
saying, “Because I bore him with sorrow.”
10 Jabez called on the God‡ of Israel,
saying, “Oh that you would bless me
indeed, and enlarge my border! May your
hand be with me, and may you keep me
from evil, that I may not cause pain!”

God granted him that which he
requested.

11 Chelub the brother of Shuhah became
the father of Mehir, who was the father of
Eshton.
12 Eshton became the father of Beth
Rapha, Paseah, and Tehinnah the father
of Ir Nahash. These are the men of Recah.
13 The sons of Kenaz: Othniel and
Seraiah. The sons of Othniel: Hathath.§
14 Meonothai became the father of
Ophrah: and Seraiah became the father of
Joab the father of Ge Harashim, for they
were craftsmen.
15 The sons of Caleb the son of
Jephunneh: Iru, Elah, and Naam. The son
of Elah: Kenaz.
16 The sons of Jehallelel: Ziph, Ziphah,
Tiria, and Asarel.
17 The sons of Ezrah: Jether, Mered,
Epher, and Jalon; and Mered’s wife bore
Miriam, Shammai, and Ishbah the father
of Eshtemoa.
18 His wife the Jewess bore Jered the
father of Gedor, Heber the father of Soco,
and Jekuthiel the father of Zanoah. These
are the sons of Bithiah the daughter of
Pharaoh, whom Mered took.
19 The sons of the wife of Hodiah, the
sister of Naham, were the fathers of
Keilah the Garmite and Eshtemoa the
Maacathite.
20 The sons of Shimon: Amnon, Rinnah,
Ben Hanan, and Tilon. The sons of Ishi:
Zoheth, and Ben Zoheth.
21 The sons of Shelah the son of Judah:
Er the father of Lecah, Laadah the father
of Mareshah, and the families of the
house of those who worked fine linen, of
the house of Ashbea;
22 and Jokim, and the men of Cozeba,
and Joash, and Saraph, who had

† **4:9** “Jabez” sounds similar to the Hebrew word for “pain”. ‡ **4:10** The Hebrew word rendered “God” is “אֱלֹהִים” (Elohim). § **4:13** Greek and Vulgate add “and Meonothai”

dominion in Moab, and Jashubilehem. These records are ancient.
23 These were the potters, and the inhabitants of Netaim and Gederah; they lived there with the king for his work.
24 The sons of Simeon: Nemuel, Jamin, Jarib, Zerah, Shaul;
25 Shallum his son, Mibsam his son, and Mishma his son.
26 The sons of Mishma: Hammuel his son, Zaccur his son, Shimei his son.
27 Shimei had sixteen sons and six daughters; but his brothers didn't have many children, and all their family didn't multiply like the children of Judah.
28 They lived at Beersheba, Moladah, Hazarshual,
29 at Bilhah, at Ezem, at Tolad,
30 at Bethuel, at Hormah, at Ziklag,
31 at Beth Marcaboth, Hazar Susim, at Beth Biri, and at Shaaraim. These were their cities until David's reign.
32 Their villages were Etam, Ain, Rimmon, Tochen, and Ashan, five cities;
33 and all their villages that were around the same cities, as far as Baal. These were their settlements, and they kept their genealogy.
34 Meshobab, Jamlech, Joshah the son of Amaziah,
35 Joel, Jehu the son of Joshibiah, the son of Seraiah, the son of Asiel,
36 Elioenai, Jaakobah, Jeshohaiah, Asaiah, Adiel, Jesimiel, Benaiah,
37 and Ziza the son of Shiphi, the son of Allon, the son of Jedaiah, the son of Shimri, the son of Shemaiah—
38 these mentioned by name were princes in their families. Their fathers' houses increased greatly.
39 They went to the entrance of Gedor, even to the east side of the valley, to seek pasture for their flocks.
40 They found rich, good pasture, and the land was wide, and quiet, and peaceful, for those who lived there before were descended from Ham.
41 These written by name came in the days of Hezekiah king of Judah, and struck their tents and the Meunim who were found there; and they destroyed them utterly to this day, and lived in their place, because there was pasture there for their flocks.
42 Some of them, even of the sons of Simeon, five hundred men, went to Mount Seir, having for their captains Pelatiah, Neariah, Rephaiah, and Uzziel, the sons of Ishi.
43 They struck the remnant of the Amalekites who escaped, and have lived there to this day.

5

1 The sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel (for he was the firstborn, but because he defiled his father's couch, his birthright was given to the sons of Joseph the son of Israel; and the genealogy is not to be listed according to the birthright.
2 For Judah prevailed above his brothers, and from him came the prince; but the birthright was Joseph's)—
3 the sons of Reuben the firstborn of Israel: Hanoch, Pallu, Hezron, and Carmi.
4 The sons of Joel: Shemaiah his son, Gog his son, Shimei his son,
5 Micah his son, Reaiah his son, Baal his son,
6 and Beerah his son, whom Tilgath Pilneser king of Assyria carried away captive. He was prince of the Reubenites.
7 His brothers by their families, when the genealogy of their generations was listed: the chief, Jeiel, and Zechariah,
8 and Bela the son of Azaz, the son of Shema, the son of Joel, who lived in Aroer, even to Nebo and Baal Meon;
9 and he lived eastward even to the entrance of the wilderness from the river Euphrates, because their livestock were multiplied in the land of Gilead.
10 In the days of Saul, they made war with the Hagrites, who fell by their hand; and they lived in their tents throughout all the land east of Gilead.
11 The sons of Gad lived beside them in the land of Bashan to Salecah:
12 Joel the chief, Shapham the second, Janai, and Shaphat in Bashan.
13 Their brothers of their fathers' houses: Michael, Meshullam, Sheba, Jorai, Jacan, Zia, and Eber, seven.
14 These were the sons of Abihail, the son of Huri, the son of Jaroah, the son of

Gilead, the son of Michael, the son of Jeshishai, the son of Jahdo, the son of Buz;
15 Ahi the son of Abdiel, the son of Guni, chief of their fathers' houses.
16 They lived in Gilead in Bashan and in its towns, and in all the pasture lands of Sharon as far as their borders.
17 All these were listed by genealogies in the days of Jotham king of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam king of Israel.

18 The sons of Reuben, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, of valiant men, men able to bear buckler and sword, able to shoot with bow, and skillful in war, were forty-four thousand seven hundred sixty that were able to go out to war.
19 They made war with the Hagrites, with Jetur, and Naphish, and Nodab.
20 They were helped against them, and the Hagrites were delivered into their hand, and all who were with them; for they cried to God in the battle, and he answered them because they put their trust in him.
21 They took away their livestock: of their camels fifty thousand, and of sheep two hundred fifty thousand, and of donkeys two thousand, and of men one hundred thousand.
22 For many fell slain, because the war was of God. They lived in their place until the captivity.

23 The children of the half-tribe of Manasseh lived in the land. They increased from Bashan to Baal Hermon, Senir, and Mount Hermon.
24 These were the heads of their fathers' houses: Epher, Ishi, Eliel, Azriel, Jeremiah, Hodaviah, and Jahdiel—mighty men of valor, famous men, heads of their fathers' houses.
25 They trespassed against the God of their fathers, and played the prostitute after the gods of the peoples of the land whom God destroyed before them.
26 So the God of Israel stirred up the spirit of Pul king of Assyria, and the spirit of Tilgath Pilneser king of Assyria, and he carried away the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh, and brought them to Halah, Habor, Hara, and to the river of Gozan, to this day.

6

1 The sons of Levi: Gershon, Kohath, and Merari.
2 The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel.
3 The children of Amram: Aaron, Moses, and Miriam. The sons of Aaron: Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar.
4 Eleazar became the father of Phinehas, Phinehas became the father of Abishua,
5 Abishua became the father of Bukki. Bukki became the father of Uzzi.
6 Uzzi became the father of Zerahiah. Zerahiah became the father of Meraioth.
7 Meraioth became the father of Amariah. Amariah became the father of Ahitub.
8 Ahitub became the father of Zadok. Zadok became the father of Ahimaaz.
9 Ahimaaz became the father of Azariah. Azariah became the father of Johanan.
10 Johanan became the father of Azariah, who executed the priest's office in the house that Solomon built in Jerusalem.
11 Azariah became the father of Amariah. Amariah became the father of Ahitub.
12 Ahitub became the father of Zadok. Zadok became the father of Shallum.
13 Shallum became the father of Hilkiah. Hilkiah became the father of Azariah.
14 Azariah became the father of Seraiah. Seraiah became the father of Jehozadak.
15 Jehozadak went into captivity when Yahweh carried Judah and Jerusalem away by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar.

16 The sons of Levi: Gershom, Kohath, and Merari.
17 These are the names of the sons of Gershom: Libni and Shimei.
18 The sons of Kohath were Amram, Izhar, Hebron, and Uzziel.
19 The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. These are the families of the Levites according to their fathers' households.
20 Of Gershom: Libni his son, Jahath his son, Zimmah his son,
21 Joah his son, Iddo his son, Zerah his son, and Jeatherai his son.
22 The sons of Kohath: Amminadab his son, Korah his son, Assir his son,
23 Elkanah his son, Ebiasaph his son, Assir his son,

24 Tahath his son, Uriel his son, Uzziah
his son, and Shaul his son.
25 The sons of Elkanah: Amasai and
Ahimoth.
26 As for Elkanah, the sons of Elkanah:
Zophai his son, Nahath his son,
27 Eliab his son, Jeroham his son, and
Elkanah his son.
28 The sons of Samuel: the firstborn,
Joel, and the second, Abijah.
29 The sons of Merari: Mahli, Libni his
son, Shimei his son, Uzzah his son,
30 Shimea his son, Haggiah his son,
Asaiah his son.
31 These are they whom David set over
the service of song in Yahweh's house
after the ark came to rest there.
32 They ministered with song before the
tabernacle of the Tent of Meeting until
Solomon had built Yahweh's house in
Jerusalem. They performed the duties of
their office according to their order.
33 These are those who served, and their
sons. Of the sons of the Kohathites:
Heman the singer, the son of Joel, the son
of Samuel,
34 the son of Elkanah, the son of
Jeroham, the son of Eliel, the son of Toah,
35 the son of Zuph, the son of Elkanah,
the son of Mahath, the son of Amasai,
36 the son of Elkanah, the son of Joel, the
son of Azariah, the son of Zephaniah,
37 the son of Tahath, the son of Assir, the
son of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah,
38 the son of Izhar, the son of Kohath,
the son of Levi, the son of Israel.
39 His brother Asaph, who stood on his
right hand, even Asaph the son of
Berechiah, the son of Shimea,
40 the son of Michael, the son of
Baaseiah, the son of Malchijah,
41 the son of Ethni, the son of Zerah, the
son of Adaiah,
42 the son of Ethan, the son of Zimmah,
the son of Shimei,
43 the son of Jahath, the son of Gershom,
the son of Levi.
44 On the left hand their brothers the
sons of Merari: Ethan the son of Kishi, the
son of Abdi, the son of Malluch,
45 the son of Hashabiah, the son of
Amaziah, the son of Hilkiah,
46 the son of Amzi, the son of Bani, the
son of Shemer,
47 the son of Mahli, the son of Mushi, the
son of Merari, the son of Levi.
48 Their brothers the Levites were
appointed for all the service of the
tabernacle of God's house.
49 But Aaron and his sons offered on the
altar of burnt offering, and on the altar of
incense, for all the work of the most holy
place, and to make atonement for Israel,
according to all that Moses the servant of
God had commanded.
50 These are the sons of Aaron: Eleazar
his son, Phinehas his son, Abishua his son,
51 Bukki his son, Uzzi his son, Zerahiah
his son,
52 Meraioth his son, Amariah his son,
Ahitub his son,
53 Zadok his son, and Ahimaaz his son.
54 Now these are their dwelling places
according to their encampments in their
borders: to the sons of Aaron, of the
families of the Kohathites (for theirs was
the first lot),
55 to them they gave Hebron in the land
of Judah, and its pasture lands around it;
56 but the fields of the city and its
villages, they gave to Caleb the son of
Jephunneh.
57 To the sons of Aaron they gave the
cities of refuge, Hebron, Libnah also with
its pasture lands, Jattir, Eshtemoa with its
pasture lands,
58 Hilen with its pasture lands, Debir
with its pasture lands,
59 Ashan with its pasture lands, and
Beth Shemesh with its pasture lands;
60 and out of the tribe of Benjamin, Geba
with its pasture lands, Allemeth with its
pasture lands, and Anathoth with its
pasture lands. All their cities throughout
their families were thirteen cities.
61 To the rest of the sons of Kohath were
given by lot, out of the family of the tribe,
out of the half-tribe, the half of Manasseh,
ten cities.
62 To the sons of Gershom, according to
their families, out of the tribe of Issachar,
and out of the tribe of Asher, and out of
the tribe of Naphtali, and out of the tribe
of Manasseh in Bashan, thirteen cities.

63 To the sons of Merari were given by
lot, according to their families, out of the
tribe of Reuben, and out of the tribe of
Gad, and out of the tribe of Zebulun,
twelve cities.
64 The children of Israel gave to the
Levites the cities with their pasture lands.
65 They gave by lot out of the tribe of the
children of Judah, and out of the tribe of
the children of Simeon, and out of the
tribe of the children of Benjamin, these
cities which are mentioned by name.

66 Some of the families of the sons of
Kohath had cities of their borders out of
the tribe of Ephraim.
67 They gave to them the cities of refuge,
Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim
with its pasture lands and Gezer with its
pasture lands,
68 Jokmeam with its pasture lands, Beth
Horon with its pasture lands,
69 Aijalon with its pasture lands, Gath
Rimmon with its pasture lands;
70 and out of the half-tribe of Manasseh,
Aner with its pasture lands, and Bileam
with its pasture lands, for the rest of the
family of the sons of Kohath.

71 To the sons of Gershom were given,
out of the family of the half-tribe of
Manasseh, Golan in Bashan with its
pasture lands, and Ashtaroth with its
pasture lands;
72 and out of the tribe of Issachar,
Kedesh with its pasture lands, Daberath
with its pasture lands,
73 Ramoth with its pasture lands, and
Anem with its pasture lands;
74 and out of the tribe of Asher, Mashal
with its pasture lands, Abdon with its
pasture lands,
75 Hukok with its pasture lands, and
Rehob with its pasture lands;
76 and out of the tribe of Naphtali,
Kedesh in Galilee with its pasture lands,
Hammon with its pasture lands, and
Kiriathaim with its pasture lands.

77 To the rest of the Levites, the sons of
Merari, were given, out of the tribe of
Zebulun, Rimmono with its pasture lands,
and Tabor with its pasture lands;
78 and beyond the Jordan at Jericho, on
the east side of the Jordan, were given
them out of the tribe of Reuben: Bezer in
the wilderness with its pasture lands,
Jahzah with its pasture lands,
79 Kedemoth with its pasture lands, and
Mephaath with its pasture lands;
80 and out of the tribe of Gad, Ramoth in
Gilead with its pasture lands, Mahanaim
with its pasture lands,
81 Heshbon with its pasture lands, and
Jazer with its pasture lands.

7

1 Of the sons of Issachar: Tola, Puah,
Jashub, and Shimron, four.
2 The sons of Tola: Uzzi, Rephaiah,
Jeriel, Jahmai, Ibsam, and Shemuel, heads
of their fathers' houses, of Tola; mighty
men of valor in their generations. Their
number in the days of David was
twenty-two thousand six hundred.
3 The son of Uzzi: Izrahiah. The sons of
Izrahiah: Michael, Obadiah, Joel, and
Isshiah, five; all of them chief men.
4 With them, by their generations, after
their fathers' houses, were bands of the
army for war, thirty-six thousand; for
they had many wives and sons.
5 Their brothers among all the families
of Issachar, mighty men of valor, listed in
all by genealogy, were eighty-seven
thousand.
6 The sons of Benjamin: Bela, Becher,
and Jediael, three.
7 The sons of Bela: Ezbon, Uzzi, Uzziel,
Jerimoth, and Iri, five; heads of fathers'
houses, mighty men of valor; and they
were listed by genealogy twenty-two
thousand thirty-four.
8 The sons of Becher: Zemirah, Joash,
Eliezer, Elioenai, Omri, Jeremoth, Abijah,
Anathoth, and Alemeth. All these were
the sons of Becher.
9 They were listed by genealogy, after
their generations, heads of their fathers'
houses, mighty men of valor, twenty
thousand two hundred.
10 The son of Jediael: Bilhan. The sons of
Bilhan: Jeush, Benjamin, Ehud,
Chenaanah, Zethan, Tarshish, and
Ahishahar.

11 All these were sons of Jediael,
according to the heads of their fathers'
households, mighty men of valor,
seventeen thousand two hundred, who
were able to go out in the army for war.
12 So were Shuppim, Huppim, the sons
of Ir, Hushim, and the sons of Aher.

13 The sons of Naphtali: Jahziel, Guni,
Jezer, Shallum, and the sons of Bilhah.

14 The sons of Manasseh: Asriel, whom
his concubine the Aramitess bore. She
bore Machir the father of Gilead.
15 Machir took a wife of Huppim and
Shuppim, whose sister's name was
Maacah. The name of the second was
Zelophehad; and Zelophehad had
daughters.
16 Maacah the wife of Machir bore a son,
and she named him Peresh. The name of
his brother was Sheresh; and his sons
were Ulam and Rakem.
17 The sons of Ulam: Bedan. These were
the sons of Gilead the son of Machir, the
son of Manasseh.
18 His sister Hammolecheth bore
Ishhod, Abiezer, and Mahlah.
19 The sons of Shemida were Ahian,
Shechem, Likhi, and Aniam.

20 The sons of Ephraim: Shuthelah,
Bered his son, Tahath his son, Eleadah his
son, Tahath his son,
21 Zabad his son, Shuthelah his son,
Ezer, and Elead, whom the men of Gath
who were born in the land killed, because
they came down to take away their
livestock.
22 Ephraim their father mourned many
days, and his brothers came to comfort
him.
23 He went in to his wife, and she
conceived and bore a son, and he named
him Beriah,† because there was trouble
with his house.
24 His daughter was Sheerah, who built
Beth Horon the lower and the upper, and
Uzzen Sheerah.
25 Rephah was his son, Resheph his son,
Telah his son, Tahan his son,
26 Ladan his son, Ammihud his son,
Elishama his son,
27 Nun his son, and Joshua his son.

28 Their possessions and settlements
were Bethel and its towns, and eastward
Naaran, and westward Gezer with its
towns; Shechem also and its towns, to
Azzah and its towns;
29 and by the borders of the children of
Manasseh, Beth Shean and its towns,
Taanach and its towns, Megiddo and its
towns, and Dor and its towns. The
children of Joseph the son of Israel lived
in these.
30 The sons of Asher: Imnah, Ishvah,
Ishvi, and Beriah. Serah was their sister.
31 The sons of Beriah: Heber and
Malchiel, who was the father of Birzaith.
32 Heber became the father of Japhlet,
Shomer, Hotham, and Shua their sister.
33 The sons of Japhlet: Pasach, Bimhal,
and Ashvath. These are the children of
Japhlet.
34 The sons of Shemer: Ahi, Rohgah,
Jehubbah, and Aram.
35 The sons of Helem his brother:
Zophah, Imna, Shelesh, and Amal.
36 The sons of Zophah: Suah,
Harnepher, Shual, Beri, Imrah,
37 Bezer, Hod, Shamma, Shilshah,
Ithran, and Beera.
38 The sons of Jether: Jephunneh, Pispa,
and Ara.
39 The sons of Ulla: Arah, Hanniel, and
Rizia.
40 All these were the children of Asher,
heads of the fathers' houses, choice and
mighty men of valor, chief of the princes.
The number of them listed by genealogy
for service in war was twenty-six
thousand men.

8

1 Benjamin became the father of Bela
his firstborn, Ashbel the second, Aharah
the third,
2 Nohah the fourth, and Rapha the fifth.
3 Bela had sons: Addar, Gera, Abihud,
4 Abishua, Naaman, Ahoah,
5 Gera, Shephuphan, and Huram.
6 These are the sons of Ehud. These are
the heads of fathers' households of the
inhabitants of Geba, who were carried
captive to Manahath:

† **7:23** "Beriah" is similar to the Hebrew word for "misfortune".

7 Naaman, Ahijah, and Gera, who
carried them captive; and he became the
father of Uzza and Ahihud.
8 Shaharaim became the father of
children in the field of Moab, after he had
sent them away. Hushim and Baara were
his wives.
9 By Hodesh his wife, he became the
father of Jobab, Zibia, Mesha, Malcam,
10 Jeuz, Shachia, and Mirmah. These
were his sons, heads of fathers'
households.
11 By Hushim, he became the father of
Abitub and Elpaal.
12 The sons of Elpaal: Eber, Misham, and
Shemed, who built Ono and Lod, with its
towns;
13 and Beriah and Shema, who were
heads of fathers' households of the
inhabitants of Aijalon, who put to flight
the inhabitants of Gath;
14 and Ahio, Shashak, Jeremoth,
15 Zebadiah, Arad, Eder,
16 Michael, Ishpah, Joha, the sons of
Beriah,
17 Zebadiah, Meshullam, Hizki, Heber,
18 Ishmerai, Izliah, Jobab, the sons of
Elpaal,
19 Jakim, Zichri, Zabdi,
20 Elienai, Zillethai, Eliel,
21 Adaiah, Beraiah, Shimrath, the sons
of Shimei,
22 Ishpan, Eber, Eliel,
23 Abdon, Zichri, Hanan,
24 Hananiah, Elam, Anthothijah,
25 Iphdeiah, Penuel, the sons of Shashak,
26 Shamsherai, Shehariah, Athaliah,
27 Jaareshiah, Elijah, Zichri, and the
sons of Jeroham.
28 These were heads of fathers'
households throughout their generations,
chief men. These lived in Jerusalem.
29 The father of Gibeon, whose wife's
name was Maacah, lived in Gibeon
30 with his firstborn son Abdon, Zur,
Kish, Baal, Nadab,
31 Gedor, Ahio, Zecher,
32 and Mikloth, who became the father
of Shimeah. They also lived with their
families in Jerusalem, near their relatives.
33 Ner became the father of Kish. Kish
became the father of Saul. Saul became
the father of Jonathan, Malchishua,
Abinadab, and Eshbaal.
34 The son of Jonathan was Merib-baal.
Merib-baal became the father of Micah.
35 The sons of Micah: Pithon, Melech,
Tarea, and Ahaz.
36 Ahaz became the father of Jehoaddah.
Jehoaddah became the father of Alemeth,
Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri became the
father of Moza.
37 Moza became the father of Binea.
Raphah was his son, Eleasah his son, and
Azel his son.
38 Azel had six sons, whose names are
these: Azrikam, Bocheru, Ishmael,
Sheariah, Obadiah, and Hanan. All these
were the sons of Azel.
39 The sons of Eshek his brother: Ulam
his firstborn, Jeush the second, and
Eliphelet the third.
40 The sons of Ulam were mighty men of
valor, archers, and had many sons, and
grandsons, one hundred fifty. All these
were of the sons of Benjamin.

9

1 So all Israel were listed by genealogies;
and behold,† they are written in the book
of the kings of Israel. Judah was carried
away captive to Babylon for their
disobedience.
2 Now the first inhabitants who lived in
their possessions in their cities were
Israel, the priests, the Levites, and the
temple servants.
3 In Jerusalem, there lived of the
children of Judah, of the children of
Benjamin, and of the children of Ephraim
and Manasseh:
4 Uthai the son of Ammihud, the son of
Omri, the son of Imri, the son of Bani, of
the children of Perez the son of Judah.
5 Of the Shilonites: Asaiah the firstborn
and his sons.
6 Of the sons of Zerah: Jeuel and their
brothers, six hundred ninety.
7 Of the sons of Benjamin: Sallu the son
of Meshullam, the son of Hodaviah, the
son of Hassenuah;

† **9:1** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

8 and Ibneiah the son of Jeroham, and
Elah the son of Uzzi, the son of Michri;
and Meshullam the son of Shephatiah, the
son of Reuel, the son of Ibnijah;
9 and their brothers, according to their
generations, nine hundred fifty-six. All
these men were heads of fathers'
households by their fathers' houses.
10 Of the priests: Jedaiah, Jehoiarib,
Jachin,
11 and Azariah the son of Hilkiah, the
son of Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the
son of Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, the
ruler of God's house;
12 and Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the
son of Pashhur, the son of Malchijah; and
Maasai the son of Adiel, the son of
Jahzerah, the son of Meshullam, the son of
Meshillemith, the son of Immer;
13 and their brothers, heads of their
fathers' houses, one thousand seven
hundred sixty; they were very able men
for the work of the service of God's house.
14 Of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of
Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of
Hashabiah, of the sons of Merari;
15 and Bakbakkar, Heresh, Galal, and
Mattaniah the son of Mica, the son of
Zichri, the son of Asaph,
16 and Obadiah the son of Shemaiah, the
son of Galal, the son of Jeduthun; and
Berechiah the son of Asa, the son of
Elkanah, who lived in the villages of the
Netophathites.
17 The gatekeepers: Shallum, Akkub,
Talmon, Ahiman, and their brothers
(Shallum was the chief),
18 who previously served in the king's
gate eastward. They were the gatekeepers
for the camp of the children of Levi.
19 Shallum was the son of Kore, the son
of Ebiasaph, the son of Korah, and his
brothers, of his father's house, the
Korahites, were over the work of the
service, keepers of the thresholds of the
tent. Their fathers had been over
Yahweh's camp, keepers of the entry.
20 Phinehas the son of Eleazar was ruler
over them in time past, and Yahweh was
with him.
21 Zechariah the son of Meshelemiah
was gatekeeper of the door of the Tent of
Meeting.
22 All these who were chosen to be
gatekeepers in the thresholds were two
hundred twelve. These were listed by
genealogy in their villages, whom David
and Samuel the seer ordained in their
office of trust.
23 So they and their children had the
oversight of the gates of Yahweh's house,
even the house of the tent, as guards.
24 On the four sides were the
gatekeepers, toward the east, west, north,
and south.
25 Their brothers, in their villages, were
to come in every seven days from time to
time to be with them,
26 for the four chief gatekeepers, who
were Levites, were in an office of trust,
and were over the rooms and over the
treasuries in God's house.
27 They stayed around God's house,
because that was their duty; and it was
their duty to open it morning by morning.
28 Certain of them were in charge of the
vessels of service, for these were brought
in by count, and these were taken out by
count.
29 Some of them also were appointed
over the furniture, and over all the vessels
of the sanctuary, over the fine flour, the
wine, the oil, the frankincense, and the
spices.
30 Some of the sons of the priests
prepared the mixing of the spices.
31 Mattithiah, one of the Levites, who
was the firstborn of Shallum the Korahite,
had the office of trust over the things that
were baked in pans.
32 Some of their brothers, of the sons of
the Kohathites, were over the show bread,
to prepare it every Sabbath.
33 These are the singers, heads of
fathers' households of the Levites, who
lived in the rooms and were free from
other service, for they were employed in
their work day and night.
34 These were heads of fathers'
households of the Levites, throughout
their generations, chief men. They lived
at Jerusalem.
35 Jeiel the father of Gibeon, whose
wife's name was Maacah, lived in Gibeon.
36 His firstborn son was Abdon, then
Zur, Kish, Baal, Ner, Nadab,

37 Gedor, Ahio, Zechariah, and Mikloth.
38 Mikloth became the father of
Shimeam. They also lived with their
relatives in Jerusalem, near their
relatives.
39 Ner became the father of Kish. Kish
became the father of Saul. Saul became
the father of Jonathan, Malchishua,
Abinadab, and Eshbaal.
40 The son of Jonathan was Merib-baal.
Merib-baal became the father of Micah.
41 The sons of Micah: Pithon, Melech,
Tahrea, and Ahaz.
42 Ahaz became the father of Jarah.
Jarah became the father of Alemeth,
Azmaveth, and Zimri. Zimri became the
father of Moza.
43 Moza became the father of Binea,
Rephaiah his son, Eleasah his son, and
Azel his son.
44 Azel had six sons, whose names are
Azrikam, Bocheru, Ishmael, Sheariah,
Obadiah, and Hanan. These were the sons
of Azel.

10

1 Now the Philistines fought against
Israel; and the men of Israel fled from
before the Philistines, and fell down slain
on Mount Gilboa.
2 The Philistines followed hard after
Saul and after his sons; and the Philistines
killed Jonathan, Abinadab, and
Malchishua, the sons of Saul.
3 The battle went hard against Saul, and
the archers overtook him; and he was
distressed by reason of the archers.
4 Then Saul said to his armor bearer,
"Draw your sword, and thrust me through
with it, lest these uncircumcised come
and abuse me."
But his armor bearer would not, for he
was terrified. Therefore Saul took his
sword and fell on it.
5 When his armor bearer saw that Saul
was dead, he likewise fell on his sword
and died.
6 So Saul died with his three sons; and
all his house died together.
7 When all the men of Israel who were
in the valley saw that they fled, and that
Saul and his sons were dead, they
abandoned their cities, and fled; and the
Philistines came and lived in them.
8 On the next day, when the Philistines
came to strip the slain, they found Saul
and his sons fallen on Mount Gilboa.
9 They stripped him and took his head
and his armor, then sent into the land of
the Philistines all around to carry the
news to their idols and to the people.
10 They put his armor in the house of
their gods, and fastened his head in the
house of Dagon.
11 When all Jabesh Gilead heard all that
the Philistines had done to Saul,
12 all the valiant men arose and took
away the body of Saul and the bodies of
his sons, and brought them to Jabesh, and
buried their bones under the oak in
Jabesh, and fasted seven days.
13 So Saul died for his trespass which he
committed against Yahweh, because of
Yahweh's word, which he didn't keep, and
also because he asked counsel of one who
had a familiar spirit, to inquire,
14 and didn't inquire of Yahweh.
Therefore he killed him, and turned the
kingdom over to David the son of Jesse.

11

1 Then all Israel gathered themselves to
David to Hebron, saying, "Behold, we are
your bone and your flesh.
2 In times past, even when Saul was
king, it was you who led out and brought
in Israel. Yahweh your God said to you,
'You shall be shepherd of my people
Israel, and you shall be prince over my
people Israel.' "
3 So all the elders of Israel came to the
king to Hebron; and David made a
covenant with them in Hebron before
Yahweh. They anointed David king over
Israel, according to Yahweh's word by
Samuel.
4 David and all Israel went to Jerusalem
(also called Jebus); and the Jebusites, the
inhabitants of the land, were there.
5 The inhabitants of Jebus said to David,
"You will not come in here!" Nevertheless
David took the stronghold of Zion. The
same is David's city.
6 David had said, "Whoever strikes the
Jebusites first shall be chief and captain."

Joab the son of Zeruiah went up first, and was made chief.
7 David lived in the stronghold;
therefore they called it David's city.
8 He built the city all around, from Millo
even around; and Joab repaired the rest
of the city.
9 David grew greater and greater, for
Yahweh of Armies was with him.
10 Now these are the chief of the mighty
men whom David had, who showed
themselves strong with him in his
kingdom, together with all Israel, to make
him king, according to Yahweh's word
concerning Israel.
11 This is the number of the mighty men
whom David had: Jashobeam, the son of a
Hachmonite, the chief of the thirty; he
lifted up his spear against three hundred
and killed them at one time.
12 After him was Eleazar the son of
Dodo, the Ahohite, who was one of the
three mighty men.
13 He was with David at Pasdammim,
and there the Philistines were gathered
together to battle, where there was a plot
of ground full of barley; and the people
fled from before the Philistines.
14 They stood in the middle of the plot,
defended it, and killed the Philistines; and
Yahweh saved them by a great victory.
15 Three of the thirty chief men went
down to the rock to David, into the cave of
Adullam; and the army of the Philistines
were encamped in the valley of Rephaim.
16 David was then in the stronghold, and
the garrison of the Philistines was in
Bethlehem at that time.
17 David longed, and said, "Oh, that
someone would give me water to drink
from the well of Bethlehem, which is by
the gate!"
18 The three broke through the army of
the Philistines, and drew water out of the
well of Bethlehem that was by the gate,
took it, and brought it to David; but David
would not drink any of it, but poured it
out to Yahweh,
19 and said, "My God forbid me, that I
should do this! Shall I drink the blood of
these men who have put their lives in
jeopardy?" For they risked their lives to
bring it. Therefore he would not drink it.
The three mighty men did these things.
20 Abishai, the brother of Joab, was chief
of the three; for he lifted up his spear
against three hundred and killed them,
and had a name among the three.
21 Of the three, he was more honorable
than the two, and was made their captain;
however he wasn't included in the three.
22 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, the son
of a valiant man of Kabzeel, who had done
mighty deeds, killed the two sons of Ariel
of Moab. He also went down and killed a
lion in the middle of a pit on a snowy day.
23 He killed an Egyptian, a man of great
stature, five cubits† high. In the Egyptian's
hand was a spear like a weaver's beam;
and he went down to him with a staff,
plucked the spear out of the Egyptian's
hand, and killed him with his own spear.
24 Benaiah the son of Jehoiada did these
things and had a name among the three
mighty men.
25 Behold, he was more honorable than
the thirty, but he didn't attain to the three;
and David set him over his guard.
26 The mighty men of the armies also
include Asahel the brother of Joab,
Elhanan the son of Dodo of Bethlehem,
27 Shammoth the Harorite, Helez the
Pelonite,
28 Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite,
Abiezer the Anathothite,
29 Sibbecai the Hushathite, Ilai the
Ahohite,
30 Maharai the Netophathite, Heled the
son of Baanah the Netophathite,
31 Ithai the son of Ribai of Gibeah of the
children of Benjamin, Benaiah the
Pirathonite,
32 Hurai of the brooks of Gaash, Abiel
the Arbathite,
33 Azmaveth the Baharumite, Eliahba
the Shaalbonite,
34 the sons of Hashem the Gizonite,
Jonathan the son of Shagee the Hararite,

† **11:23** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. Therefore this Egyptian was about 7 feet and 6 inches or 2.28 meters tall.

35 Ahiam the son of Sacar the Hararite,
Eliphal the son of Ur,
36 Hepher the Mecherathite, Ahijah the
Pelonite,
37 Hezro the Carmelite, Naarai the son
of Ezbai,
38 Joel the brother of Nathan, Mibhar
the son of Hagri,
39 Zelek the Ammonite, Naharai the
Berothite (the armor bearer of Joab the
son of Zeruiah),
40 Ira the Ithrite, Gareb the Ithrite,
41 Uriah the Hittite, Zabad the son of
Ahlai,
42 Adina the son of Shiza the Reubenite
(a chief of the Reubenites), and thirty with
him,
43 Hanan the son of Maacah, Joshaphat
the Mithnite,
44 Uzzia the Ashterathite, Shama and
Jeiel the sons of Hotham the Aroerite,
45 Jediael the son of Shimri, and Joha his
brother, the Tizite,
46 Eliel the Mahavite, and Jeribai, and
Joshaviah, the sons of Elnaam, and
Ithmah the Moabite,
47 Eliel, Obed, and Jaasiel the Mezobaite.

12

1 Now these are those who came to
David to Ziklag while he was a fugitive
from Saul the son of Kish. They were
among the mighty men, his helpers in
war.
2 They were armed with bows, and
could use both the right hand and the left
in slinging stones and in shooting arrows
from the bow. They were of Saul's
relatives of the tribe of Benjamin.
3 The chief was Ahiezer, then Joash, the
sons of Shemaah the Gibeathite; Jeziel
and Pelet, the sons of Azmaveth; Beracah;
Jehu the Anathothite;
4 Ishmaiah the Gibeonite, a mighty man
among the thirty and a leader of the
thirty; Jeremiah; Jahaziel; Johanan;
Jozabad the Gederathite;
5 Eluzai; Jerimoth; Bealiah; Shemariah;
Shephatiah the Haruphite;
6 Elkanah, Isshiah, Azarel, Joezer, and
Jashobeam, the Korahites;
7 and Joelah and Zebadiah, the sons of
Jeroham of Gedor.
8 Some Gadites joined David in the
stronghold in the wilderness, mighty men
of valor, men trained for war, who could
handle shield and spear; whose faces
were like the faces of lions, and they were
as swift as the gazelles on the mountains:
9 Ezer the chief, Obadiah the second,
Eliab the third,
10 Mishmannah the fourth, Jeremiah the
fifth,
11 Attai the sixth, Eliel the seventh,
12 Johanan the eighth, Elzabad the
ninth,
13 Jeremiah the tenth, and Machbannai
the eleventh.
14 These of the sons of Gad were
captains of the army. He who was least
was equal to one hundred, and the
greatest to one thousand.
15 These are those who went over the
Jordan in the first month, when it had
overflowed all its banks; and they put to
flight all who lived in the valleys, both
toward the east and toward the west.
16 Some of the children of Benjamin and
Judah came to the stronghold to David.
17 David went out to meet them, and
answered them, "If you have come
peaceably to me to help me, my heart will
be united with you; but if you have come
to betray me to my adversaries, since
there is no wrong in my hands, may the
God of our fathers see this and rebuke it."
18 Then the Spirit came on Amasai, who
was chief of the thirty, and he said, "We
are yours, David, and on your side, you
son of Jesse. Peace, peace be to you, and
peace be to your helpers; for your God
helps you." Then David received them
and made them captains of the band.
19 Some of Manasseh also joined David
when he came with the Philistines against
Saul to battle, but they didn't help them,
for the lords of the Philistines sent him
away after consultation, saying, "He will
desert to his master Saul to the jeopardy
of our heads."
20 As he went to Ziklag, some from
Manasseh joined him: Adnah, Jozabad,
Jediael, Michael, Jozabad, Elihu, and

Zillethai, captains of thousands who were of Manasseh.
21 They helped David against the band of raiders, for they were all mighty men of valor and were captains in the army.
22 For from day to day men came to David to help him, until there was a great army, like God's army.
23 These are the numbers of the heads of those who were armed for war, who came to David to Hebron to turn the kingdom of Saul to him, according to Yahweh's word.
24 The children of Judah who bore shield and spear were six thousand eight hundred, armed for war.
25 Of the children of Simeon, mighty men of valor for the war: seven thousand one hundred.
26 Of the children of Levi: four thousand six hundred.
27 Jehoiada was the leader of the household of Aaron; and with him were three thousand seven hundred,
28 and Zadok, a young man mighty of valor, and of his father's house twenty-two captains.
29 Of the children of Benjamin, Saul's relatives: three thousand, for until then, the greatest part of them had kept their allegiance to Saul's house.
30 Of the children of Ephraim: twenty thousand eight hundred, mighty men of valor, famous men in their fathers' houses.
31 Of the half-tribe of Manasseh: eighteen thousand, who were mentioned by name, to come and make David king.
32 Of the children of Issachar, men who had understanding of the times, to know what Israel ought to do, their heads were two hundred; and all their brothers were at their command.
33 Of Zebulun, such as were able to go out in the army, who could set the battle in array with all kinds of instruments of war: fifty thousand who could command and were not of double heart.
34 Of Naphtali: one thousand captains, and with them with shield and spear thirty-seven thousand.
35 Of the Danites who could set the battle in array: twenty-eight thousand six hundred.
36 Of Asher, such as were able to go out in the army, who could set the battle in array: forty thousand.
37 On the other side of the Jordan, of the Reubenites, the Gadites, and of the half-tribe of Manasseh, with all kinds of instruments of war for the battle: one hundred twenty thousand.
38 All these were men of war who could order the battle array, and came with a perfect heart to Hebron to make David king over all Israel; and all the rest also of Israel were of one heart to make David king.
39 They were there with David three days, eating and drinking; for their brothers had supplied provisions for them.
40 Moreover those who were near to them, as far as Issachar, Zebulun, and Naphtali, brought bread on donkeys, on camels, on mules, and on oxen: supplies of flour, cakes of figs, clusters of raisins, wine, oil, cattle, and sheep in abundance; for there was joy in Israel.

13

1 David consulted with the captains of thousands and of hundreds, even with every leader.
2 David said to all the assembly of Israel, "If it seems good to you, and if it is of Yahweh our God, let's send word everywhere to our brothers who are left in all the land of Israel, with whom the priests and Levites are in their cities that have pasture lands, that they may gather themselves to us.
3 Also, let's bring the ark of our God back to us again, for we didn't seek it in the days of Saul."
4 All the assembly said that they would do so, for the thing was right in the eyes of all the people.
5 So David assembled all Israel together, from the Shihor River of Egypt even to the entrance of Hamath, to bring God's ark from Kiriath Jearim.
6 David went up with all Israel to Baalah, that is, to Kiriath Jearim, which belonged to Judah, to bring up from there

God Yahweh's ark that sits above the cherubim, that is called by the Name.
7 They carried God's ark on a new cart, and brought it out of Abinadab's house; and Uzza and Ahio drove the cart.
8 David and all Israel played before God with all their might, even with songs, with harps, with stringed instruments, with tambourines, with cymbals, and with trumpets.
9 When they came to Chidon's threshing floor, Uzza put out his hand to hold the ark, for the oxen stumbled.
10 Yahweh's anger burned against Uzza, and he struck him because he put his hand on the ark; and he died there before God.
11 David was displeased, because Yahweh had broken out against Uzza. He called that place Perez Uzza, to this day.
12 David was afraid of God that day, saying, "How can I bring God's ark home to me?"
13 So David didn't move the ark with him into David's city, but carried it aside into Obed-Edom the Gittite's house.
14 God's ark remained with the family of Obed-Edom in his house three months; and Yahweh blessed Obed-Edom's house and all that he had.

14

1 Hiram king of Tyre sent messengers to David with cedar trees, masons, and carpenters, to build him a house.
2 David perceived that Yahweh had established him king over Israel, for his kingdom was highly exalted, for his people Israel's sake.
3 David took more wives in Jerusalem, and David became the father of more sons and daughters.
4 These are the names of the children whom he had in Jerusalem: Shammua, Shobab, Nathan, Solomon,
5 Ibhar, Elishua, Elpelet,
6 Nogah, Nepheg, Japhia,
7 Elishama, Beeliada, and Eliphelet.
8 When the Philistines heard that David was anointed king over all Israel, all the Philistines went up to seek David; and David heard of it, and went out against them.
9 Now the Philistines had come and made a raid in the valley of Rephaim.
10 David inquired of God, saying, "Shall I go up against the Philistines? Will you deliver them into my hand?"

Yahweh said to him, "Go up; for I will deliver them into your hand."
11 So they came up to Baal Perazim, and David defeated them there. David said, God has broken my enemies by my hand, like waters breaking out. Therefore they called the name of that place Baal Perazim.†
12 They left their gods there; and David gave a command, and they were burned with fire.
13 The Philistines made another raid in the valley.
14 David inquired again of God; and God said to him, "You shall not go up after them. Turn away from them, and come on them opposite the mulberry trees.
15 When you hear the sound of marching in the tops of the mulberry trees, then go out to battle; for God has gone out before you to strike the army of the Philistines."
16 David did as God commanded him; and they attacked the army of the Philistines from Gibeon even to Gezer.
17 The fame of David went out into all lands; and Yahweh brought the fear of him on all nations.

15

1 David made himself houses in David's city; and he prepared a place for God's ark, and pitched a tent for it.
2 Then David said, "No one ought to carry God's ark but the Levites. For Yahweh has chosen them to carry God's ark, and to minister to him forever."
3 David assembled all Israel at Jerusalem, to bring up Yahweh's ark to its place, which he had prepared for it.
4 David gathered together the sons of Aaron and the Levites:
5 of the sons of Kohath, Uriel the chief, and his brothers one hundred twenty;

† **14:11** "Baal Perazim" means "The Lord who breaks out".

6 of the sons of Merari, Asaiah the chief,
and his brothers two hundred twenty;
7 of the sons of Gershom, Joel the chief,
and his brothers one hundred thirty;
8 of the sons of Elizaphan, Shemaiah the
chief, and his brothers two hundred;
9 of the sons of Hebron, Eliel the chief,
and his brothers eighty;
10 of the sons of Uzziel, Amminadab the
chief, and his brothers one hundred
twelve.
11 David called for Zadok and Abiathar
the priests, and for the Levites: for Uriel,
Asaiah, Joel, Shemaiah, Eliel, and
Amminadab,
12 and said to them, "You are the heads
of the fathers' households of the Levites.
Sanctify yourselves, both you and your
brothers, that you may bring the ark of
Yahweh, the God of Israel, up to the place
that I have prepared for it.
13 For because you didn't carry it at first,
Yahweh our God broke out in anger
against us, because we didn't seek him
according to the ordinance."
14 So the priests and the Levites
sanctified themselves to bring up the ark
of Yahweh, the God of Israel.
15 The children of the Levites bore God's
ark on their shoulders with its poles, as
Moses commanded according to Yahweh's
word.
16 David spoke to the chief of the Levites
to appoint their brothers as singers with
instruments of music, stringed
instruments, harps, and cymbals,
sounding aloud and lifting up their voices
with joy.
17 So the Levites appointed Heman the
son of Joel; and of his brothers, Asaph the
son of Berechiah; and of the sons of
Merari their brothers, Ethan the son of
Kushaiah;
18 and with them their brothers of the
second rank: Zechariah, Ben, Jaaziel,
Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Unni, Eliab,
Benaiah, Maaseiah, Mattithiah,
Eliphelehu, Mikneiah, Obed-Edom, and
Jeiel, the doorkeepers.
19 So the singers, Heman, Asaph, and
Ethan, were given cymbals of bronze to
sound aloud;
20 and Zechariah, Aziel, Shemiramoth,
Jehiel, Unni, Eliab, Maaseiah, and
Benaiah, with stringed instruments set to
Alamoth;
21 and Mattithiah, Eliphelehu,
Mikneiah, Obed-Edom, Jeiel, and Azaziah,
with harps tuned to the eight-stringed
lyre, to lead.
22 Chenaniah, chief of the Levites, was
over the singing. He taught the singers,
because he was skillful.
23 Berechiah and Elkanah were
doorkeepers for the ark.
24 Shebaniah, Joshaphat, Nethanel,
Amasai, Zechariah, Benaiah, and Eliezer,
the priests, blew the trumpets before
God's ark; and Obed-Edom and Jehiah
were doorkeepers for the ark.
25 So David, the elders of Israel, and the
captains over thousands went to bring the
ark of Yahweh's covenant up out of the
house of Obed-Edom with joy.
26 When God helped the Levites who
bore the ark of Yahweh's covenant, they
sacrificed seven bulls and seven rams.
27 David was clothed with a robe of fine
linen, as were all the Levites who bore the
ark, the singers, and Chenaniah the choir
master with the singers; and David had an
ephod of linen on him.
28 Thus all Israel brought the ark of
Yahweh's covenant up with shouting,
with sound of the cornet, with trumpets,
and with cymbals, sounding aloud with
stringed instruments and harps.
29 As the ark of Yahweh's covenant
came to David's city, Michal the daughter
of Saul looked out at the window, and saw
king David dancing and playing; and she
despised him in her heart.

16

1 They brought in God's ark, and set it in
the middle of the tent that David had
pitched for it; and they offered burnt
offerings and peace offerings before God.
2 When David had finished offering the
burnt offering and the peace offerings, he
blessed the people in Yahweh's name.
3 He gave to everyone of Israel, both
man and woman, to everyone a loaf of

bread, a portion of meat, and a cake of raisins.
4 He appointed some of the Levites to minister before Yahweh's ark, and to commemorate, to thank, and to praise Yahweh, the God of Israel:
5 Asaph the chief, and second to him Zechariah, then Jeiel, Shemiramoth, Jehiel, Mattithiah, Eliab, Benaiah, Obed-Edom, and Jeiel, with stringed instruments and with harps; and Asaph with cymbals, sounding aloud;
6 with Benaiah and Jahaziel the priests with trumpets continually, before the ark of the covenant of God.
7 Then on that day David first ordained giving of thanks to Yahweh by the hand of Asaph and his brothers.
8 Oh give thanks to Yahweh.
Call on his name.
Make what he has done known among the peoples.
9 Sing to him.
Sing praises to him.
Tell of all his marvelous works.
10 Glory in his holy name.
Let the heart of those who seek Yahweh rejoice.
11 Seek Yahweh and his strength.
Seek his face forever more.
12 Remember his marvelous works that he has done,
his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth,
13 you offspring† of Israel his servant,
you children of Jacob, his chosen ones.

14 He is Yahweh our God.
His judgments are in all the earth.
15 Remember his covenant forever,
the word which he commanded to a thousand generations,
16 the covenant which he made with Abraham,
his oath to Isaac.
17 He confirmed it to Jacob for a statute,
and to Israel for an everlasting covenant,
18 saying, "I will give you the land of Canaan,
The lot of your inheritance,"
19 when you were but a few men in number,
yes, very few, and foreigners in it.
20 They went about from nation to nation,
from one kingdom to another people.
21 He allowed no man to do them wrong.
Yes, he reproved kings for their sakes,
22 "Don't touch my anointed ones!
Do my prophets no harm!"

23 Sing to Yahweh, all the earth!
Display his salvation from day to day.
24 Declare his glory among the nations,
and his marvelous works among all the peoples.
25 For great is Yahweh, and greatly to be praised.
He also is to be feared above all gods.
26 For all the gods of the peoples are idols,
but Yahweh made the heavens.
27 Honor and majesty are before him.
Strength and gladness are in his place.

28 Ascribe to Yahweh, you families of the peoples,
ascribe to Yahweh glory and strength!
29 Ascribe to Yahweh the glory due to his name.
Bring an offering, and come before him.
Worship Yahweh in holy array.
30 Tremble before him, all the earth.
The world also is established that it can't be moved.
31 Let the heavens be glad,
and let the earth rejoice!
Let them say among the nations, "Yahweh reigns!"
32 Let the sea roar, and its fullness!
Let the field exult, and all that is in it!
33 Then the trees of the forest will sing for joy before Yahweh,
for he comes to judge the earth.
34 Oh give thanks to Yahweh, for he is good,
for his loving kindness endures forever.
35 Say, "Save us, God of our salvation!
Gather us together and deliver us from the nations,

† **16:13** or, seed

to give thanks to your holy name,
to triumph in your praise."
36 Blessed be Yahweh, the God of Israel,
from everlasting even to everlasting.
All the people said, "Amen," and praised Yahweh.
37 So he left Asaph and his brothers there before the ark of Yahweh's covenant, to minister before the ark continually, as every day's work required;
38 and Obed-Edom with their sixty-eight relatives; Obed-Edom also the son of Jeduthun and Hosah to be doorkeepers;
39 and Zadok the priest and his brothers the priests, before Yahweh's tabernacle in the high place that was at Gibeon,
40 to offer burnt offerings to Yahweh on the altar of burnt offering continually morning and evening, even according to all that is written in Yahweh's law, which he commanded to Israel;
41 and with them Heman and Jeduthun and the rest who were chosen, who were mentioned by name, to give thanks to Yahweh, because his loving kindness endures forever;
42 and with them Heman and Jeduthun with trumpets and cymbals for those that should sound aloud, and with instruments for the songs of God, and the sons of Jeduthun to be at the gate.
43 All the people departed, each man to his house; and David returned to bless his house.

17

1 When David was living in his house, David said to Nathan the prophet, "Behold, I live in a cedar house, but the ark of Yahweh's covenant is in a tent."
2 Nathan said to David, "Do all that is in your heart; for God is with you."
3 That same night, the word of God came to Nathan, saying,
4 "Go and tell David my servant, 'Yahweh says, "You shall not build me a house to dwell in;
5 for I have not lived in a house since the day that I brought up Israel to this day, but have gone from tent to tent, and from one tent to another.
6 In all places in which I have walked with all Israel, did I speak a word with any of the judges of Israel, whom I commanded to be shepherd of my people, saying, 'Why have you not built me a house of cedar?' " '
7 "Now therefore, you shall tell my servant David, 'Yahweh of Armies says, "I took you from the sheep pen, from following the sheep, to be prince over my people Israel.
8 I have been with you wherever you have gone, and have cut off all your enemies from before you. I will make you a name like the name of the great ones who are in the earth.
9 I will appoint a place for my people Israel, and will plant them, that they may dwell in their own place, and be moved no more. The children of wickedness will not waste them any more, as at the first,
10 and from the day that I commanded judges to be over my people Israel. I will subdue all your enemies. Moreover I tell you that Yahweh will build you a house.
11 It will happen, when your days are fulfilled that you must go to be with your fathers, that I will set up your offspring after you, who will be of your sons; and I will establish his kingdom.
12 He will build me a house, and I will establish his throne forever.
13 I will be his father, and he will be my son. I will not take my loving kindness away from him, as I took it from him who was before you;
14 but I will settle him in my house and in my kingdom forever. His throne will be established forever." ' "
15 According to all these words, and according to all this vision, so Nathan spoke to David.

16 Then David the king went in and sat before Yahweh; and he said, "Who am I, Yahweh God, and what is my house, that you have brought me this far?
17 This was a small thing in your eyes, O God, but you have spoken of your servant's house for a great while to come, and have respected me according to the

standard of a man of high degree, Yahweh God.
18 What can David say yet more to you concerning the honor which is done to your servant? For you know your servant.
19 Yahweh, for your servant's sake, and according to your own heart, you have done all this greatness, to make known all these great things.
20 Yahweh, there is no one like you, neither is there any God besides you, according to all that we have heard with our ears.
21 What one nation in the earth is like your people Israel, whom God went to redeem to himself for a people, to make you a name by great and awesome things, in driving out nations from before your people whom you redeemed out of Egypt?
22 For you made your people Israel your own people forever; and you, Yahweh, became their God.
23 Now, Yahweh, let the word that you have spoken concerning your servant, and concerning his house, be established forever, and do as you have spoken.
24 Let your name be established and magnified forever, saying, 'Yahweh of Armies is the God of Israel, even a God to Israel. The house of David your servant is established before you.'
25 For you, my God, have revealed to your servant that you will build him a house. Therefore your servant has found courage to pray before you.
26 Now, Yahweh, you are God, and have promised this good thing to your servant.
27 Now it has pleased you to bless the house of your servant, that it may continue forever before you; for you, Yahweh, have blessed, and it is blessed forever."

18

1 After this, David defeated the Philistines and subdued them, and took Gath and its towns out of the hand of the Philistines.
2 He defeated Moab; and the Moabites became servants to David and brought tribute.
3 David defeated Hadadezer king of Zobah, toward Hamath, as he went to establish his dominion by the river Euphrates.
4 David took from him one thousand chariots, seven thousand horsemen, and twenty thousand footmen; and David hamstrung all the chariot horses, but reserved of them enough for one hundred chariots.
5 When the Syrians of Damascus came to help Hadadezer king of Zobah, David struck twenty-two thousand men of the Syrians.
6 Then David put garrisons in Syria of Damascus; and the Syrians became servants to David and brought tribute. Yahweh gave victory to David wherever he went.
7 David took the shields of gold that were on the servants of Hadadezer, and brought them to Jerusalem.
8 From Tibhath and from Cun, cities of Hadadezer, David took very much bronze, with which Solomon made the bronze sea, the pillars, and the vessels of bronze.
9 When Tou king of Hamath heard that David had struck all the army of Hadadezer king of Zobah,
10 he sent Hadoram his son to King David to greet him and to bless him, because he had fought against Hadadezer and struck him (for Hadadezer had wars with Tou); and he had with him all kinds of vessels of gold and silver and bronze.
11 King David also dedicated these to Yahweh, with the silver and the gold that he carried away from all the nations: from Edom, from Moab, from the children of Ammon, from the Philistines, and from Amalek.
12 Moreover Abishai the son of Zeruiah struck eighteen thousand of the Edomites in the Valley of Salt.
13 He put garrisons in Edom; and all the Edomites became servants to David. Yahweh gave victory to David wherever he went.
14 David reigned over all Israel; and he executed justice and righteousness for all his people.

15 Joab the son of Zeruiah was over the army; Jehoshaphat the son of Ahilud was recorder;
16 Zadok the son of Ahitub and Abimelech the son of Abiathar were priests; Shavsha was scribe;
17 and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada was over the Cherethites and the Pelethites; and the sons of David were chief officials serving the king.

19

1 After this, Nahash the king of the children of Ammon died, and his son reigned in his place.
2 David said, "I will show kindness to Hanun the son of Nahash, because his father showed kindness to me."

So David sent messengers to comfort him concerning his father. David's servants came into the land of the children of Ammon to Hanun to comfort him.
3 But the princes of the children of Ammon said to Hanun, "Do you think that David honors your father, in that he has sent comforters to you? Haven't his servants come to you to search, to overthrow, and to spy out the land?"
4 So Hanun took David's servants, shaved them, and cut off their garments in the middle at their buttocks, and sent them away.
5 Then some people went and told David how the men were treated. He sent to meet them; for the men were greatly humiliated. The king said, "Stay at Jericho until your beards have grown, and then return."
6 When the children of Ammon saw that they had made themselves odious to David, Hanun and the children of Ammon sent one thousand talents† of silver to hire chariots and horsemen out of Mesopotamia, out of Aram-maacah, and out of Zobah.
7 So they hired for themselves thirty-two thousand chariots, and the king of Maacah with his people, who came and encamped near Medeba. The children of Ammon gathered themselves together from their cities, and came to battle.
8 When David heard of it, he sent Joab with all the army of the mighty men.
9 The children of Ammon came out, and put the battle in array at the gate of the city; and the kings who had come were by themselves in the field.
10 Now when Joab saw that the battle was set against him before and behind, he chose some of all the choice men of Israel, and put them in array against the Syrians.
11 The rest of the people he committed into the hand of Abishai his brother; and they put themselves in array against the children of Ammon.
12 He said, "If the Syrians are too strong for me, then you are to help me; but if the children of Ammon are too strong for you, then I will help you.
13 Be courageous, and let's be strong for our people and for the cities of our God. May Yahweh do that which seems good to him."
14 So Joab and the people who were with him came near to the front of the Syrians to the battle; and they fled before him.
15 When the children of Ammon saw that the Syrians had fled, they likewise fled before Abishai his brother, and entered into the city. Then Joab came to Jerusalem.

16 When the Syrians saw that they were defeated by Israel, they sent messengers and called out the Syrians who were beyond the River,‡ with Shophach the captain of the army of Hadadezer leading them.
17 David was told that, so he gathered all Israel together, passed over the Jordan, came to them, and set the battle in array against them. So when David had put the battle in array against the Syrians, they fought with him.
18 The Syrians fled before Israel; and David killed of the Syrian men seven thousand charioteers and forty thousand footmen, and also killed Shophach the captain of the army.

† **19:6** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds, so 1000 talents is about 30 metric tons ‡ **19:16** or, the Euphrates River

19 When the servants of Hadadezer saw
that they were defeated by Israel, they
made peace with David and served him.
The Syrians would not help the children
of Ammon any more.

20

1 At the time of the return of the year, at
the time when kings go out, Joab led out
the army and wasted the country of the
children of Ammon, and came and
besieged Rabbah. But David stayed at
Jerusalem. Joab struck Rabbah, and
overthrew it.
2 David took the crown of their king
from off his head, and found it to weigh a
talent of gold,† and there were precious
stones in it. It was set on David's head,
and he brought very much plunder out of
the city.
3 He brought out the people who were
in it, and had them cut with saws, with
iron picks, and with axes. David did so to
all the cities of the children of Ammon.
Then David and all the people returned to
Jerusalem.
4 After this, war arose at Gezer with the
Philistines. Then Sibbecai the Hushathite
killed Sippai, of the sons of the giant; and
they were subdued.
5 Again there was war with the
Philistines; and Elhanan the son of Jair
killed Lahmi the brother of Goliath the
Gittite, the staff of whose spear was like a
weaver's beam.
6 There was again war at Gath, where
there was a man of great stature, who had
twenty-four fingers and toes, six on each
hand and six on each foot; and he also
was born to the giant.
7 When he defied Israel, Jonathan the
son of Shimea, David's brother, killed him.
8 These were born to the giant in Gath;
and they fell by the hand of David and by
the hand of his servants.

21

1 Satan stood up against Israel, and
moved David to take a census of Israel.
2 David said to Joab and to the princes of
the people, "Go, count Israel from
Beersheba even to Dan; and bring me
word, that I may know how many there
are."
3 Joab said, "May Yahweh make his
people a hundred times as many as they
are. But, my lord the king, aren't they all
my lord's servants? Why does my lord
require this thing? Why will he be a cause
of guilt to Israel?"
4 Nevertheless the king's word
prevailed against Joab. Therefore Joab
departed and went throughout all Israel,
then came to Jerusalem.
5 Joab gave the sum of the census of the
people to David. All those of Israel were
one million one hundred thousand men
who drew a sword; and in Judah were
four hundred seventy thousand men who
drew a sword.
6 But he didn't count Levi and Benjamin
among them, for the king's word was
abominable to Joab.
7 God was displeased with this thing;
therefore he struck Israel.
8 David said to God, "I have sinned
greatly, in that I have done this thing. But
now put away, I beg you, the iniquity of
your servant, for I have done very
foolishly."
9 Yahweh spoke to Gad, David's seer,
saying,
10 "Go and speak to David, saying,
'Yahweh says, "I offer you three things.
Choose one of them, that I may do it to
you." ' "
11 So Gad came to David and said to him,
"Yahweh says, 'Take your choice:
12 either three years of famine; or three
months to be consumed before your foes,
while the sword of your enemies
overtakes you; or else three days of the
sword of Yahweh, even pestilence in the
land, and Yahweh's angel destroying
throughout all the borders of Israel. Now
therefore consider what answer I shall
return to him who sent me.' "
13 David said to Gad, "I am in distress.
Let me fall, I pray, into Yahweh's hand, for
his mercies are very great. Don't let me
fall into man's hand."

† **20:2** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

14 So Yahweh sent a pestilence on Israel,
and seventy thousand men of Israel fell.
15 God sent an angel to Jerusalem to
destroy it. As he was about to destroy,
Yahweh saw, and he relented of the
disaster, and said to the destroying angel,
"It is enough. Now withdraw your hand."
Yahweh's angel was standing by the
threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite.
16 David lifted up his eyes, and saw
Yahweh's angel standing between earth
and the sky, having a drawn sword in his
hand stretched out over Jerusalem.

Then David and the elders, clothed in
sackcloth, fell on their faces.
17 David said to God, "Isn't it I who
commanded the people to be counted? It
is even I who have sinned and done very
wickedly; but these sheep, what have they
done? Please let your hand, O Yahweh my
God, be against me and against my
father's house; but not against your
people, that they should be plagued."
18 Then Yahweh's angel commanded
Gad to tell David that David should go up
and raise an altar to Yahweh on the
threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite.
19 David went up at the saying of Gad,
which he spoke in Yahweh's name.
20 Ornan turned back and saw the
angel; and his four sons who were with
him hid themselves. Now Ornan was
threshing wheat.
21 As David came to Ornan, Ornan
looked and saw David, and went out of the
threshing floor, and bowed himself to
David with his face to the ground.
22 Then David said to Ornan, "Sell me
the place of this threshing floor, that I may
build an altar to Yahweh on it. You shall
sell it to me for the full price, that the
plague may be stopped from afflicting the
people."
23 Ornan said to David, "Take it for
yourself, and let my lord the king do that
which is good in his eyes. Behold, I give
the oxen for burnt offerings, and the
threshing instruments for wood, and the
wheat for the meal offering. I give it all."
24 King David said to Ornan, "No, but I
will most certainly buy it for the full price.
For I will not take that which is yours for
Yahweh, nor offer a burnt offering that
costs me nothing."
25 So David gave to Ornan six hundred
shekels† of gold by weight for the place.
26 David built an altar to Yahweh there,
and offered burnt offerings and peace
offerings, and called on Yahweh; and he
answered him from the sky by fire on the
altar of burnt offering.
27 Then Yahweh commanded the angel,
and he put his sword back into its sheath.
28 At that time, when David saw that
Yahweh had answered him in the
threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite, then
he sacrificed there.
29 For Yahweh's tabernacle, which
Moses made in the wilderness, and the
altar of burnt offering, were at that time
in the high place at Gibeon.
30 But David couldn't go before it to
inquire of God, for he was afraid because
of the sword of Yahweh's angel.

22

1 Then David said, "This is the house of
Yahweh God, and this is the altar of burnt
offering for Israel."
2 David gave orders to gather together
the foreigners who were in the land of
Israel; and he set masons to cut dressed
stones to build God's house.
3 David prepared iron in abundance for
the nails for the doors of the gates and for
the couplings, and bronze in abundance
without weight,
4 and cedar trees without number, for
the Sidonians and the people of Tyre
brought cedar trees in abundance to
David.
5 David said, "Solomon my son is young
and tender, and the house that is to be
built for Yahweh must be exceedingly
magnificent, of fame and of glory
throughout all countries. I will therefore
make preparation for it." So David
prepared abundantly before his death.

† **21:25** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 600 shekels was about 6 kilograms or about 192 Troy ounces.

6 Then he called for Solomon his son,
and commanded him to build a house for
Yahweh, the God of Israel.
7 David said to Solomon his son, "As for
me, it was in my heart to build a house to
the name of Yahweh my God.
8 But Yahweh's word came to me,
saying, 'You have shed blood abundantly
and have made great wars. You shall not
build a house to my name, because you
have shed much blood on the earth in my
sight.
9 Behold, a son shall be born to you, who
shall be a man of peace. I will give him
rest from all his enemies all around; for
his name shall be Solomon, and I will give
peace and quietness to Israel in his days.
10 He shall build a house for my name;
and he will be my son, and I will be his
father; and I will establish the throne of
his kingdom over Israel forever.'
11 Now, my son, may Yahweh be with
you and prosper you, and build the house
of Yahweh your God, as he has spoken
concerning you.
12 May Yahweh give you discretion and
understanding, and put you in charge of
Israel, so that you may keep the law of
Yahweh your God.
13 Then you will prosper, if you observe
to do the statutes and the ordinances
which Yahweh gave Moses concerning
Israel. Be strong and courageous. Don't be
afraid and don't be dismayed.
14 Now, behold, in my affliction I have
prepared for Yahweh's house one
hundred thousand talents† of gold, one
million talents‡ of silver, and bronze and
iron without weight; for it is in
abundance. I have also prepared timber
and stone; and you may add to them.
15 There are also workmen with you in
abundance—cutters and workers of stone
and timber, and all kinds of men who are
skillful in every kind of work;
16 of the gold, the silver, the bronze, and
the iron, there is no number. Arise and be
doing, and may Yahweh be with you."
17 David also commanded all the princes
of Israel to help Solomon his son, saying,
18 "Isn't Yahweh your God with you?
Hasn't he given you rest on every side?
For he has delivered the inhabitants of the
land into my hand; and the land is
subdued before Yahweh and before his
people.
19 Now set your heart and your soul to
follow Yahweh your God. Arise therefore,
and build the sanctuary of Yahweh God, to
bring the ark of Yahweh's covenant and
the holy vessels of God into the house that
is to be built for Yahweh's name."

23

1 Now David was old and full of days;
and he made Solomon his son king over
Israel.
2 He gathered together all the princes of
Israel, with the priests and the Levites.
3 The Levites were counted from thirty
years old and upward; and their number
by their polls, man by man, was
thirty-eight thousand.
4 David said, "Of these, twenty-four
thousand were to oversee the work of
Yahweh's house, six thousand were
officers and judges,
5 four thousand were doorkeepers, and
four thousand praised Yahweh with the
instruments which I made for giving
praise."
6 David divided them into divisions
according to the sons of Levi: Gershon,
Kohath, and Merari.
7 Of the Gershonites: Ladan and Shimei.
8 The sons of Ladan: Jehiel the chief,
Zetham, and Joel, three.
9 The sons of Shimei: Shelomoth, Haziel,
and Haran, three. These were the heads of
the fathers' households of Ladan.
10 The sons of Shimei: Jahath, Zina,
Jeush, and Beriah. These four were the
sons of Shimei.
11 Jahath was the chief, and Zizah the
second; but Jeush and Beriah didn't have
many sons; therefore they became a
fathers' house in one reckoning.
12 The sons of Kohath: Amram, Izhar,
Hebron, and Uzziel, four.

† **22:14** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 100,000 talents is about 3 metric tons
‡ **22:14** about 30,000 metric tons

13 The sons of Amram: Aaron and
Moses; and Aaron was separated that he
should sanctify the most holy things, he
and his sons forever, to burn incense
before Yahweh, to minister to him, and to
bless in his name forever.
14 But as for Moses the man of God, his
sons were named among the tribe of Levi.
15 The sons of Moses: Gershom and
Eliezer.
16 The sons of Gershom: Shebuel the
chief.
17 The son of Eliezer was Rehabiah the
chief; and Eliezer had no other sons, but
the sons of Rehabiah were very many.
18 The son of Izhar: Shelomith the chief.
19 The sons of Hebron: Jeriah the chief,
Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third,
and Jekameam the fourth.
20 The sons of Uzziel: Micah the chief,
and Isshiah the second.
21 The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi.
The sons of Mahli: Eleazar and Kish.
22 Eleazar died, and had no sons, but
daughters only; and their relatives, the
sons of Kish, took them as wives.
23 The sons of Mushi: Mahli, Eder, and
Jeremoth, three.

24 These were the sons of Levi after
their fathers' houses, even the heads of
the fathers' houses of those who were
counted individually, in the number of
names by their polls, who did the work for
the service of Yahweh's house, from
twenty years old and upward.
25 For David said, "Yahweh, the God of
Israel, has given rest to his people; and he
dwells in Jerusalem forever.
26 Also the Levites will no longer need to
carry the tabernacle and all its vessels for
its service."
27 For by the last words of David the
sons of Levi were counted, from twenty
years old and upward.
28 For their duty was to wait on the sons
of Aaron for the service of Yahweh's
house—in the courts, in the rooms, and in
the purifying of all holy things, even the
work of the service of God's house;
29 for the show bread also, and for the
fine flour for a meal offering, whether of
unleavened wafers, or of that which is
baked in the pan, or of that which is
soaked, and for all measurements of
quantity and size;
30 and to stand every morning to thank
and praise Yahweh, and likewise in the
evening;
31 and to offer all burnt offerings to
Yahweh on the Sabbaths, on the new
moons, and on the set feasts, in number
according to the ordinance concerning
them, continually before Yahweh;
32 and that they should keep the duty of
the Tent of Meeting, the duty of the holy
place, and the duty of the sons of Aaron
their brothers for the service of Yahweh's
house.

24

1 These were the divisions of the sons of
Aaron. The sons of Aaron: Nadab, Abihu,
Eleazar, and Ithamar.
2 But Nadab and Abihu died before their
father, and had no children; therefore
Eleazar and Ithamar served as priests.
3 David, with Zadok of the sons of
Eleazar and Ahimelech of the sons of
Ithamar, divided them according to their
ordering in their service.
4 There were more chief men found of
the sons of Eleazar than of the sons of
Ithamar; and they were divided like this:
of the sons of Eleazar there were sixteen,
heads of fathers' houses; and of the sons
of Ithamar, according to their fathers'
houses, eight.
5 Thus they were divided impartially by
drawing lots; for there were princes of the
sanctuary and princes of God, both of the
sons of Eleazar, and of the sons of
Ithamar.
6 Shemaiah the son of Nethanel the
scribe, who was of the Levites, wrote them
in the presence of the king, the princes,
Zadok the priest, Ahimelech the son of
Abiathar, and the heads of the fathers'
households of the priests and of the
Levites; one fathers' house being taken for
Eleazar, and one taken for Ithamar.
7 Now the first lot came out to Jehoiarib,
the second to Jedaiah,
8 the third to Harim, the fourth to
Seorim,
9 the fifth to Malchijah, the sixth to
Mijamin,

10 the seventh to Hakkoz, the eighth to Abijah,
11 the ninth to Jeshua, the tenth to Shecaniah,
12 the eleventh to Eliashib, the twelfth to Jakim,
13 the thirteenth to Huppah, the fourteenth to Jeshebeab,
14 the fifteenth to Bilgah, the sixteenth to Immer,
15 the seventeenth to Hezir, the eighteenth to Happizzez,
16 the nineteenth to Pethahiah, the twentieth to Jehezkel,
17 the twenty-first to Jachin, the twenty-second to Gamul,
18 the twenty-third to Delaiah, and the twenty-fourth to Maaziah.
19 This was their ordering in their service, to come into Yahweh's house according to the ordinance given to them by Aaron their father, as Yahweh, the God of Israel, had commanded him.

20 Of the rest of the sons of Levi: of the sons of Amram, Shubael; of the sons of Shubael, Jehdeiah.
21 Of Rehabiah: of the sons of Rehabiah, Isshiah the chief.
22 Of the Izharites, Shelomoth; of the sons of Shelomoth, Jahath.
23 The sons of Hebron: Jeriah, Amariah the second, Jahaziel the third, and Jekameam the fourth.
24 The sons of Uzziel: Micah; of the sons of Micah, Shamir.
25 The brother of Micah: Isshiah; of the sons of Isshiah, Zechariah.
26 The sons of Merari: Mahli and Mushi. The son of Jaaziah: Beno.
27 The sons of Merari by Jaaziah: Beno, Shoham, Zaccur, and Ibri.
28 Of Mahli: Eleazar, who had no sons.
29 Of Kish, the son of Kish: Jerahmeel.
30 The sons of Mushi: Mahli, Eder, and Jerimoth. These were the sons of the Levites after their fathers' houses.
31 These likewise cast lots even as their brothers the sons of Aaron in the presence of David the king, Zadok, Ahimelech, and the heads of the fathers' households of the priests and of the Levites, the fathers' households of the chief even as those of his younger brother.

25

1 Moreover, David and the captains of the army set apart for the service certain of the sons of Asaph, of Heman, and of Jeduthun, who were to prophesy with harps, with stringed instruments, and with cymbals. The number of those who did the work according to their service was:
2 of the sons of Asaph: Zaccur, Joseph, Nethaniah, and Asharelah. The sons of Asaph were under the hand of Asaph, who prophesied at the order of the king.
3 Of Jeduthun, the sons of Jeduthun: Gedaliah, Zeri, Jeshaiah, Shimei, Hashabiah, and Mattithiah, six, under the hands of their father Jeduthun, who prophesied in giving thanks and praising Yahweh with the harp.
4 Of Heman, the sons of Heman: Bukkiah, Mattaniah, Uzziel, Shebuel, Jerimoth, Hananiah, Hanani, Eliathah, Giddalti, Romamti-Ezer, Joshbekashah, Mallothi, Hothir, and Mahazioth.
5 All these were the sons of Heman the king's seer in the words of God, to lift up the horn. God gave to Heman fourteen sons and three daughters.
6 All these were under the hands of their father for song in Yahweh's house, with cymbals, stringed instruments, and harps, for the service of God's house: Asaph, Jeduthun, and Heman being under the order of the king.
7 The number of them, with their brothers who were instructed in singing to Yahweh, even all who were skillful, was two hundred eighty-eight.
8 They cast lots for their offices, all alike, the small as well as the great, the teacher as well as the student.
9 Now the first lot came out for Asaph to Joseph; the second to Gedaliah, he and his brothers and sons were twelve;
10 the third to Zaccur, his sons and his brothers, twelve;
11 the fourth to Izri, his sons and his brothers, twelve;

12 the fifth to Nethaniah, his sons and
his brothers, twelve;
13 the sixth to Bukkiah, his sons and his
brothers, twelve;
14 the seventh to Jesharelah, his sons
and his brothers, twelve;
15 the eighth to Jeshaiah, his sons and
his brothers, twelve;
16 the ninth to Mattaniah, his sons and
his brothers, twelve;
17 the tenth to Shimei, his sons and his
brothers, twelve;
18 the eleventh to Azarel, his sons and
his brothers, twelve;
19 the twelfth to Hashabiah, his sons and
his brothers, twelve;
20 for the thirteenth, Shubael, his sons
and his brothers, twelve;
21 for the fourteenth, Mattithiah, his
sons and his brothers, twelve;
22 for the fifteenth to Jeremoth, his sons
and his brothers, twelve;
23 for the sixteenth to Hananiah, his
sons and his brothers, twelve;
24 for the seventeenth to Joshbekashah,
his sons and his brothers, twelve;
25 for the eighteenth to Hanani, his sons
and his brothers, twelve;
26 for the nineteenth to Mallothi, his
sons and his brothers, twelve;
27 for the twentieth to Eliathah, his sons
and his brothers, twelve;
28 for the twenty-first to Hothir, his sons
and his brothers, twelve;
29 for the twenty-second to Giddalti, his
sons and his brothers, twelve;
30 for the twenty-third to Mahazioth, his
sons and his brothers, twelve;
31 for the twenty-fourth to
Romamti-Ezer, his sons and his brothers,
twelve.

26

1 For the divisions of the doorkeepers:
of the Korahites, Meshelemiah the son of
Kore, of the sons of Asaph.
2 Meshelemiah had sons: Zechariah the
firstborn, Jediael the second, Zebadiah the
third, Jathniel the fourth,
3 Elam the fifth, Jehohanan the sixth,
and Eliehoenai the seventh.
4 Obed-Edom had sons: Shemaiah the
firstborn, Jehozabad the second, Joah the
third, Sacar the fourth, Nethanel the fifth,
5 Ammiel the sixth, Issachar the
seventh, and Peullethai the eighth; for
God blessed him.
6 Sons were also born to Shemaiah his
son, who ruled over the house of their
father; for they were mighty men of valor.
7 The sons of Shemaiah: Othni, Rephael,
Obed, and Elzabad, whose relatives were
valiant men, Elihu, and Semachiah.
8 All these were of the sons of
Obed-Edom with their sons and their
brothers, able men in strength for the
service: sixty-two of Obed-Edom.
9 Meshelemiah had sons and brothers,
eighteen valiant men.
10 Also Hosah, of the children of Merari,
had sons: Shimri the chief (for though he
was not the firstborn, yet his father made
him chief),
11 Hilkiah the second, Tebaliah the
third, and Zechariah the fourth. All the
sons and brothers of Hosah were thirteen.
12 Of these were the divisions of the
doorkeepers, even of the chief men,
having offices like their brothers, to
minister in Yahweh's house.
13 They cast lots, the small as well as the
great, according to their fathers' houses,
for every gate.
14 The lot eastward fell to Shelemiah.
Then for Zechariah his son, a wise
counselor, they cast lots; and his lot came
out northward.
15 To Obed-Edom southward; and to his
sons the storehouse.
16 To Shuppim and Hosah westward, by
the gate of Shallecheth, at the causeway
that goes up, watchman opposite
watchman.
17 Eastward were six Levites,
northward four a day, southward four a
day, and for the storehouse two and two.
18 For Parbar westward, four at the
causeway, and two at Parbar.
19 These were the divisions of the
doorkeepers; of the sons of the Korahites,
and of the sons of Merari.
20 Of the Levites, Ahijah was over the
treasures of God's house and over the
treasures of the dedicated things.

21 The sons of Ladan, the sons of the
Gershonites belonging to Ladan, the
heads of the fathers' households
belonging to Ladan the Gershonite:
Jehieli.
22 The sons of Jehieli: Zetham, and Joel
his brother, over the treasures of
Yahweh's house.
23 Of the Amramites, of the Izharites, of
the Hebronites, of the Uzzielites:
24 Shebuel the son of Gershom, the son
of Moses, was ruler over the treasuries.
25 His brothers: of Eliezer, Rehabiah his
son, and Jeshaiah his son, and Joram his
son, and Zichri his son, and Shelomoth his
son.
26 This Shelomoth and his brothers
were over all the treasuries of the
dedicated things, which David the king,
and the heads of the fathers' households,
the captains over thousands and
hundreds, and the captains of the army,
had dedicated.
27 They dedicated some of the plunder
won in battles to repair Yahweh's house.
28 All that Samuel the seer, Saul the son
of Kish, Abner the son of Ner, and Joab the
son of Zeruiah had dedicated, whoever
had dedicated anything, it was under the
hand of Shelomoth and of his brothers.
29 Of the Izharites, Chenaniah and his
sons were appointed to the outward
business over Israel, for officers and
judges.
30 Of the Hebronites, Hashabiah and his
brothers, one thousand seven hundred
men of valor, had the oversight of Israel
beyond the Jordan westward, for all the
business of Yahweh and for the service of
the king.
31 Of the Hebronites, Jerijah was the
chief of the Hebronites, according to their
generations by fathers' households. They
were sought for in the fortieth year of the
reign of David, and mighty men of valor
were found among them at Jazer of
Gilead.
32 His relatives, men of valor, were two
thousand seven hundred, heads of
fathers' households, whom King David
made overseers over the Reubenites, the
Gadites, and the half-tribe of the
Manassites, for every matter pertaining to
God and for the affairs of the king.

27

1 Now the children of Israel after their
number, the heads of fathers' households
and the captains of thousands and of
hundreds, and their officers who served
the king in any matter of the divisions
which came in and went out month by
month throughout all the months of the
year—of every division were twenty-four
thousand.
2 Over the first division for the first
month was Jashobeam the son of Zabdiel.
In his division were twenty-four
thousand.
3 He was of the children of Perez, the
chief of all the captains of the army for the
first month.
4 Over the division of the second month
was Dodai the Ahohite and his division,
and Mikloth the ruler; and in his division
were twenty-four thousand.
5 The third captain of the army for the
third month was Benaiah, the son of
Jehoiada the chief priest. In his division
were twenty-four thousand.
6 This is that Benaiah who was the
mighty man of the thirty and over the
thirty. Of his division was Ammizabad his
son.
7 The fourth captain for the fourth
month was Asahel the brother of Joab,
and Zebadiah his son after him. In his
division were twenty-four thousand.
8 The fifth captain for the fifth month
was Shamhuth the Izrahite. In his
division were twenty-four thousand.
9 The sixth captain for the sixth month
was Ira the son of Ikkesh the Tekoite. In
his division were twenty-four thousand.
10 The seventh captain for the seventh
month was Helez the Pelonite, of the
children of Ephraim. In his division were
twenty-four thousand.
11 The eighth captain for the eighth
month was Sibbecai the Hushathite, of the
Zerahites. In his division were
twenty-four thousand.
12 The ninth captain for the ninth month
was Abiezer the Anathothite, of the
Benjamites. In his division were
twenty-four thousand.

13 The tenth captain for the tenth month
was Maharai the Netophathite, of the
Zerahites. In his division were
twenty-four thousand.
14 The eleventh captain for the eleventh
month was Benaiah the Pirathonite, of the
children of Ephraim. In his division were
twenty-four thousand.
15 The twelfth captain for the twelfth
month was Heldai the Netophathite, of
Othniel. In his division were twenty-four
thousand.
16 Furthermore over the tribes of Israel:
of the Reubenites, Eliezer the son of Zichri
was the ruler; of the Simeonites,
Shephatiah the son of Maacah;
17 of Levi, Hashabiah the son of Kemuel;
of Aaron, Zadok;
18 of Judah, Elihu, one of the brothers of
David; of Issachar, Omri the son of
Michael;
19 of Zebulun, Ishmaiah the son of
Obadiah; of Naphtali, Jeremoth the son of
Azriel;
20 of the children of Ephraim, Hoshea
the son of Azaziah; of the half-tribe of
Manasseh, Joel the son of Pedaiah;
21 of the half-tribe of Manasseh in
Gilead, Iddo the son of Zechariah; of
Benjamin, Jaasiel the son of Abner;
22 of Dan, Azarel the son of Jeroham.
These were the captains of the tribes of
Israel.
23 But David didn't take the number of
them from twenty years old and under,
because Yahweh had said he would
increase Israel like the stars of the sky.
24 Joab the son of Zeruiah began to take
a census, but didn't finish; and wrath
came on Israel for this. The number
wasn't put into the account in the
chronicles of King David.

25 Over the king's treasures was
Azmaveth the son of Adiel. Over the
treasures in the fields, in the cities, in the
villages, and in the towers was Jonathan
the son of Uzziah;
26 Over those who did the work of the
field for tillage of the ground was Ezri the
son of Chelub.
27 Over the vineyards was Shimei the
Ramathite. Over the increase of the
vineyards for the wine cellars was Zabdi
the Shiphmite.
28 Over the olive trees and the sycamore
trees that were in the lowland was Baal
Hanan the Gederite. Over the cellars of oil
was Joash.
29 Over the herds that fed in Sharon was
Shitrai the Sharonite. Over the herds that
were in the valleys was Shaphat the son of
Adlai.
30 Over the camels was Obil the
Ishmaelite. Over the donkeys was
Jehdeiah the Meronothite. Over the flocks
was Jaziz the Hagrite.
31 All these were the rulers of the
property which was King David's.
32 Also Jonathan, David's uncle, was a
counselor, a man of understanding, and a
scribe. Jehiel the son of Hachmoni was
with the king's sons.
33 Ahithophel was the king's counselor.
Hushai the Archite was the king's friend.
34 After Ahithophel was Jehoiada the
son of Benaiah, and Abiathar. Joab was
the captain of the king's army.

28

1 David assembled all the princes of
Israel, the princes of the tribes, the
captains of the companies who served the
king by division, the captains of
thousands, the captains of hundreds, and
the rulers over all the substance and
possessions of the king and of his sons,
with the officers and the mighty men,
even all the mighty men of valor, to
Jerusalem.
2 Then David the king stood up on his
feet and said, "Hear me, my brothers and
my people! As for me, it was in my heart
to build a house of rest for the ark of
Yahweh's covenant, and for the footstool
of our God; and I had prepared for the
building.
3 But God said to me, 'You shall not build
a house for my name, because you are a
man of war and have shed blood.'
4 However Yahweh, the God of Israel,
chose me out of all the house of my father
to be king over Israel forever. For he has
chosen Judah to be prince; and in the
house of Judah, the house of my father;

and among the sons of my father he took pleasure in me to make me king over all Israel.
5 Of all my sons (for Yahweh has given me many sons), he has chosen Solomon my son to sit on the throne of Yahweh's kingdom over Israel.
6 He said to me, 'Solomon, your son, shall build my house and my courts; for I have chosen him to be my son, and I will be his father.
7 I will establish his kingdom forever if he continues to do my commandments and my ordinances, as it is today.'

8 Now therefore, in the sight of all Israel, Yahweh's assembly, and in the audience of our God, observe and seek out all the commandments of Yahweh your God, that you may possess this good land, and leave it for an inheritance to your children after you forever.

9 You, Solomon my son, know the God of your father, and serve him with a perfect heart and with a willing mind; for Yahweh searches all hearts, and understands all the imaginations of the thoughts. If you seek him, he will be found by you; but if you forsake him, he will cast you off forever.
10 Take heed now, for Yahweh has chosen you to build a house for the sanctuary. Be strong, and do it."

11 Then David gave to Solomon his son the plans for the porch of the temple, for its houses, for its treasuries, for its upper rooms, for its inner rooms, for the place of the mercy seat;
12 and the plans of all that he had by the Spirit, for the courts of Yahweh's house, for all the surrounding rooms, for the treasuries of God's house, and for the treasuries of the dedicated things;
13 also for the divisions of the priests and the Levites, for all the work of the service of Yahweh's house, and for all the vessels of service in Yahweh's house—
14 of gold by weight for the gold for all vessels of every kind of service, for all the vessels of silver by weight, for all vessels of every kind of service;
15 by weight also for the lamp stands of gold, and for its lamps, of gold, by weight for every lamp stand and for its lamps; and for the lamp stands of silver, by weight for every lamp stand and for its lamps, according to the use of every lamp stand;
16 and the gold by weight for the tables of show bread, for every table; and silver for the tables of silver;
17 and the forks, the basins, and the cups, of pure gold; and for the golden bowls by weight for every bowl; and for the silver bowls by weight for every bowl;
18 and for the altar of incense, refined gold by weight; and gold for the plans for the chariot, and the cherubim that spread out and cover the ark of Yahweh's covenant.
19 "All this", David said, "I have been made to understand in writing from Yahweh's hand, even all the works of this pattern."
20 David said to Solomon his son, "Be strong and courageous, and do it. Don't be afraid, nor be dismayed, for Yahweh God, even my God, is with you. He will not fail you nor forsake you, until all the work for the service of Yahweh's house is finished.
21 Behold, there are the divisions of the priests and the Levites for all the service of God's house. Every willing man who has skill for any kind of service shall be with you in all kinds of work. Also the captains and all the people will be entirely at your command."

29

1 David the king said to all the assembly, "Solomon my son, whom alone God has chosen, is yet young and tender, and the work is great; for the palace is not for man, but for Yahweh God.
2 Now I have prepared with all my might for the house of my God the gold for the things of gold, the silver for the things of silver, the bronze for the things of bronze, iron for the things of iron, and wood for the things of wood, also onyx stones, stones to be set, stones for inlaid work of various colors, all kinds of precious stones, and marble stones in abundance.

3 In addition, because I have set my
affection on the house of my God, since I
have a treasure of my own of gold and
silver, I give it to the house of my God,
over and above all that I have prepared
for the holy house:
4 even three thousand talents of gold,† of the gold of Ophir, and seven thousand talents‡ of refined silver, with which to overlay the walls of the houses;
5 of gold for the things of gold, and of
silver for the things of silver, and for all
kinds of work to be made by the hands of
artisans. Who then offers willingly to
consecrate himself today to Yahweh?"
6 Then the princes of the fathers'
households, and the princes of the tribes
of Israel, and the captains of thousands
and of hundreds, with the rulers over the
king's work, offered willingly;
7 and they gave for the service of God's
house of gold five thousand talents§ and
ten thousand darics,† of silver ten
thousand talents, of bronze eighteen
thousand talents, and of iron one hundred
thousand talents.
8 People with whom precious stones
were found gave them to the treasure of
Yahweh's house, under the hand of Jehiel
the Gershonite.
9 Then the people rejoiced, because they
offered willingly, because with a perfect
heart they offered willingly to Yahweh;
and David the king also rejoiced with
great joy.

10 Therefore David blessed Yahweh
before all the assembly; and David said,
"You are blessed, Yahweh, the God of
Israel our father, forever and ever.
11 Yours, Yahweh, is the greatness, the
power, the glory, the victory, and the
majesty! For all that is in the heavens and
in the earth is yours. Yours is the
kingdom, Yahweh, and you are exalted as
head above all.
12 Both riches and honor come from
you, and you rule over all! In your hand is
power and might! It is in your hand to
make great, and to give strength to all!
13 Now therefore, our God, we thank
you and praise your glorious name.
14 But who am I, and what is my people,
that we should be able to offer so willingly
as this? For all things come from you, and
we have given you of your own.
15 For we are strangers before you and
foreigners, as all our fathers were. Our
days on the earth are as a shadow, and
there is no remaining.
16 Yahweh our God, all this store that we
have prepared to build you a house for
your holy name comes from your hand,
and is all your own.
17 I know also, my God, that you try the
heart and have pleasure in uprightness.
As for me, in the uprightness of my heart I
have willingly offered all these things.
Now I have seen with joy your people,
who are present here, offer willingly to
you.
18 Yahweh, the God of Abraham, of
Isaac, and of Israel, our fathers, keep this
desire forever in the thoughts of the heart
of your people, and prepare their heart
for you;
19 and give to Solomon my son a perfect
heart, to keep your commandments, your
testimonies, and your statutes, and to do
all these things, and to build the palace,
for which I have made provision."

20 Then David said to all the assembly,
"Now bless Yahweh your God!"

All the assembly blessed Yahweh, the
God of their fathers, and bowed down
their heads and prostrated themselves
before Yahweh and the king.
21 They sacrificed sacrifices to Yahweh
and offered burnt offerings to Yahweh on
the next day after that day, even one
thousand bulls, one thousand rams, and
one thousand lambs, with their drink
offerings and sacrifices in abundance for
all Israel,

† **29:4** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 3000 talents is about 90 metric tons ‡ **29:4** about 210 metric tons § **29:7** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 5000 talents is about 150 metric tons † **29:7** a daric was a gold coin issued by a Persian king, weighing about 8.4 grams or about 0.27 troy ounces each.

22 and ate and drank before Yahweh on
that day with great gladness. They made
Solomon the son of David king the second
time, and anointed him before Yahweh to
be prince, and Zadok to be priest.
23 Then Solomon sat on the throne of
Yahweh as king instead of David his
father, and prospered; and all Israel
obeyed him.
24 All the princes, the mighty men, and
also all of the sons of King David
submitted themselves to Solomon the
king.
25 Yahweh magnified Solomon
exceedingly in the sight of all Israel, and
gave to him such royal majesty as had not
been on any king before him in Israel.
26 Now David the son of Jesse reigned
over all Israel.
27 The time that he reigned over Israel
was forty years; he reigned seven years in
Hebron, and he reigned thirty-three years
in Jerusalem.
28 He died at a good old age, full of days,
riches, and honor; and Solomon his son
reigned in his place.
29 Now the acts of David the king, first
and last, behold, they are written in the
history of Samuel the seer, and in the
history of Nathan the prophet, and in the
history of Gad the seer,
30 with all his reign and his might, and
the events that involved him, Israel, and
all the kingdoms of the lands.

The Second Book of Chronicles

1 Solomon the son of David was firmly
established in his kingdom, and Yahweh† his God‡ was with him, and made him exceedingly great.
2 Solomon spoke to all Israel, to the captains of thousands and of hundreds, to the judges, and to every prince in all Israel, the heads of the fathers' households.
3 Then Solomon, and all the assembly with him, went to the high place that was at Gibeon; for God's Tent of Meeting was there, which Yahweh's servant Moses had made in the wilderness.
4 But David had brought God's ark up from Kiriath Jearim to the place that David had prepared for it; for he had pitched a tent for it at Jerusalem.
5 Moreover the bronze altar that Bezalel the son of Uri, the son of Hur, had made was there before Yahweh's tabernacle; and Solomon and the assembly were seeking counsel there.
6 Solomon went up there to the bronze altar before Yahweh, which was at the Tent of Meeting, and offered one thousand burnt offerings on it.
7 That night, God appeared to Solomon and said to him, "Ask for what you want me to give you."
8 Solomon said to God, "You have shown great loving kindness to David my father, and have made me king in his place.
9 Now, Yahweh God, let your promise to David my father be established; for you have made me king over a people like the dust of the earth in multitude.
10 Now give me wisdom and knowledge, that I may go out and come in before this people; for who can judge this great people of yours?"
11 God said to Solomon, "Because this was in your heart, and you have not asked riches, wealth, honor, or the life of those who hate you, nor yet have you asked for long life; but have asked for wisdom and knowledge for yourself, that you may judge my people, over whom I have made you king,
12 therefore wisdom and knowledge is granted to you. I will give you riches, wealth, and honor, such as none of the kings have had who have been before you, and none after you will have."
13 So Solomon came from the high place that was at Gibeon, from before the Tent of Meeting, to Jerusalem; and he reigned over Israel.
14 Solomon gathered chariots and horsemen. He had one thousand four hundred chariots and twelve thousand horsemen that he placed in the chariot cities, and with the king at Jerusalem.
15 The king made silver and gold to be as common as stones in Jerusalem, and he made cedars to be as common as the sycamore trees that are in the lowland.
16 The horses which Solomon had were brought out of Egypt and from Kue. The king's merchants purchased them from Kue.
17 They imported from Egypt then exported a chariot for six hundred pieces of silver and a horse for one hundred fifty.§ They also exported them to the Hittite kings and the Syrian† kings.

2

1 Now Solomon decided to build a house for Yahweh's name, and a house for his kingdom.
2 Solomon counted out seventy thousand men to bear burdens, eighty thousand men who were stone cutters in the mountains, and three thousand six hundred to oversee them.
3 Solomon sent to Huram the king of Tyre, saying, "As you dealt with David my

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:1** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). § **1:17** The pieces of silver were probably shekels, so 600 pieces would be about 13.2 pounds or 6 kilograms of silver, and 150 would be about 3.3 pounds or 1.5 kilograms of silver. † **1:17** or, Aramean † **2:4** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

father, and sent him cedars to build him a house in which to dwell, so deal with me.
4 Behold,† I am about to build a house for the name of Yahweh my God, to dedicate it to him, to burn before him incense of sweet spices, for the continual show bread, and for the burnt offerings morning and evening, on the Sabbaths, on the new moons, and on the set feasts of Yahweh our God. This is an ordinance forever to Israel.
5 "The house which I am building will be great, for our God is greater than all gods.
6 But who is able to build him a house, since heaven and the heaven of heavens can't contain him? Who am I then, that I should build him a house, except just to burn incense before him?
7 "Now therefore send me a man skillful to work in gold, in silver, in bronze, in iron, and in purple, crimson, and blue, and who knows how to engrave engravings, to be with the skillful men who are with me in Judah and in Jerusalem, whom David my father provided.
8 "Send me also cedar trees, cypress trees, and algum trees out of Lebanon, for I know that your servants know how to cut timber in Lebanon. Behold, my servants will be with your servants,
9 even to prepare timber in abundance for me; for the house which I am about to build will be great and wonderful.
10 Behold, I will give to your servants, the cutters who cut timber, twenty thousand cors‡ of beaten wheat, twenty thousand baths§ of barley, twenty thousand baths of wine, and twenty thousand baths of oil."
11 Then Huram the king of Tyre answered in writing, which he sent to Solomon, "Because Yahweh loves his people, he has made you king over them."
12 Huram continued, "Blessed be Yahweh, the God of Israel, who made heaven and earth, who has given to David the king a wise son, endowed with discretion and understanding, who would build a house for Yahweh and a house for his kingdom.
13 Now I have sent a skillful man, endowed with understanding, Huram-abi,†
14 the son of a woman of the daughters of Dan; and his father was a man of Tyre. He is skillful to work in gold, in silver, in bronze, in iron, in stone, in timber, in purple, in blue, in fine linen, and in crimson, also to engrave any kind of engraving and to devise any device, that there may be a place appointed to him with your skillful men, and with the skillful men of my lord David your father.
15 "Now therefore, the wheat, the barley, the oil, and the wine which my lord has spoken of, let him send to his servants;
16 and we will cut wood out of Lebanon, as much as you need. We will bring it to you in rafts by sea to Joppa; then you shall carry it up to Jerusalem."
17 Solomon counted all the foreigners who were in the land of Israel, after the census with which David his father had counted them; and they found one hundred fifty-three thousand six hundred.
18 He set seventy thousand of them to bear burdens, eighty thousand who were stone cutters in the mountains, and three thousand six hundred overseers to assign the people their work.

3

1 Then Solomon began to build Yahweh's house at Jerusalem on Mount Moriah, where Yahweh appeared to David his father, which he prepared in the place that David had appointed, on the threshing floor of Ornan the Jebusite.
2 He began to build in the second day of the second month, in the fourth year of his reign.

‡ **2:10** 1 cor is the same as a homer, or about 55.9 U. S. gallons (liquid) or 211 liters or 6 bushels, so 20,000 cors of wheat would weigh about 545 metric tons § **2:10** 1 bath is one tenth of a cor, or about 5.6 U. S. gallons or 21 liters or 2.4 pecks. 20,000 baths of barley would weigh about 262 metric tons. † **2:13** or, Huram, my father † **3:3** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

3 Now these are the foundations which
Solomon laid for the building of God's
house: the length by cubits† after the first
measure was sixty cubits, and the width
twenty cubits.
4 The porch that was in front, its length,
across the width of the house, was twenty
cubits, and the height one hundred
twenty; and he overlaid it within with
pure gold.
5 He made the larger room with a
ceiling of cypress wood, which he
overlaid with fine gold, and ornamented
it with palm trees and chains.
6 He decorated the house with precious
stones for beauty. The gold was gold from
Parvaim.
7 He also overlaid the house, the beams,
the thresholds, its walls, and its doors
with gold, and engraved cherubim on the
walls.
8 He made the most holy place. Its
length, according to the width of the
house, was twenty cubits, and its width
twenty cubits; and he overlaid it with fine
gold, amounting to six hundred talents.‡
9 The weight of the nails was fifty
shekels§ of gold. He overlaid the upper
rooms with gold.
10 In the most holy place he made two
cherubim by carving, and they overlaid
them with gold.
11 The wings of the cherubim were
twenty cubits long: the wing of the one
was five cubits, reaching to the wall of the
house; and the other wing was five cubits,
reaching to the wing of the other cherub.
12 The wing of the other cherub was five
cubits, reaching to the wall of the house;
and the other wing was five cubits, joining
to the wing of the other cherub.
13 The wings of these cherubim spread
themselves out twenty cubits. They stood
on their feet, and their faces were toward
the house.
14 He made the veil of blue, purple,
crimson, and fine linen, and ornamented
it with cherubim.
15 Also he made before the house two
pillars thirty-five cubits high, and the
capital that was on the top of each of them
was five cubits.
16 He made chains in the inner
sanctuary, and put them on the tops of the
pillars; and he made one hundred
pomegranates, and put them on the
chains.
17 He set up the pillars before the
temple, one on the right hand and the
other on the left; and called the name of
that on the right hand Jachin, and the
name of that on the left Boaz.

4

1 Then he made an altar of bronze,
twenty cubits† long, twenty cubits wide,
and ten cubits high.
2 Also he made the molten sea‡ of ten
cubits from brim to brim. It was round,
five cubits high, and thirty cubits in
circumference.
3 Under it was the likeness of oxen,
which encircled it, for ten cubits,
encircling the sea. The oxen were in two
rows, cast when it was cast.
4 It stood on twelve oxen, three looking
toward the north, three looking toward
the west, three looking toward the south,
and three looking toward the east; and the
sea was set on them above, and all their
hindquarters were inward.
5 It was a handbreadth thick. Its brim
was made like the brim of a cup, like the
flower of a lily. It received and held three
thousand baths.§
6 He also made ten basins, and put five
on the right hand and five on the left, to
wash in them. The things that belonged to
the burnt offering were washed in them,
but the sea was for the priests to wash in.
7 He made the ten lamp stands of gold
according to the ordinance concerning

‡ **3:8** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 600 talents is about 18 metric tons § **3:9** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 50 shekels was about 0.5 kilograms or about 16 Troy ounces.
† **4:1** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. ‡ **4:2** or, pool, or, reservoir § **4:5** A bath is about 5.6 U. S. gallons or 21.1 liters, so 3,000 baths is about 16,800 gallons or 63.3 kiloliters.

them; and he set them in the temple, five on the right hand and five on the left.
8 He made also ten tables, and placed them in the temple, five on the right side and five on the left. He made one hundred basins of gold.
9 Furthermore he made the court of the priests, the great court, and doors for the court, and overlaid their doors with bronze.
10 He set the sea on the right side of the house eastward, toward the south.
11 Huram made the pots, the shovels, and the basins.

So Huram finished doing the work that he did for King Solomon in God's house:
12 the two pillars, the bowls, the two capitals which were on the top of the pillars, the two networks to cover the two bowls of the capitals that were on the top of the pillars,
13 and the four hundred pomegranates for the two networks—two rows of pomegranates for each network, to cover the two bowls of the capitals that were on the pillars.
14 He also made the bases, and he made the basins on the bases—
15 one sea, and the twelve oxen under it.
16 Huram-abi† also made the pots, the shovels, the forks, and all its vessels for King Solomon, for Yahweh's house, of bright bronze.
17 The king cast them in the plain of the Jordan, in the clay ground between Succoth and Zeredah.
18 Thus Solomon made all these vessels in great abundance, so that the weight of the bronze could not be determined.
19 Solomon made all the vessels that were in God's house: the golden altar, the tables with the show bread on them,
20 and the lamp stands with their lamps to burn according to the ordinance before the inner sanctuary, of pure gold;
21 and the flowers, the lamps, and the tongs of gold that was purest gold;
22 and the snuffers, the basins, the spoons, and the fire pans of pure gold. As for the entry of the house, its inner doors for the most holy place and the doors of the main hall of the temple were of gold.

5

1 Thus all the work that Solomon did for Yahweh's house was finished. Solomon brought in the things that David his father had dedicated, even the silver, the gold, and all the vessels, and put them in the treasuries of God's house.
2 Then Solomon assembled the elders of Israel and all the heads of the tribes, the princes of the fathers' households of the children of Israel, to Jerusalem, to bring up the ark of Yahweh's covenant out of David's city, which is Zion.
3 So all the men of Israel assembled themselves to the king at the feast, which was in the seventh month.
4 All the elders of Israel came. The Levites took up the ark.
5 They brought up the ark, the Tent of Meeting, and all the holy vessels that were in the Tent. The Levitical priests brought these up.
6 King Solomon and all the congregation of Israel who were assembled to him were before the ark, sacrificing sheep and cattle that could not be counted or numbered for multitude.
7 The priests brought in the ark of Yahweh's covenant to its place, into the inner sanctuary of the house, to the most holy place, even under the wings of the cherubim.
8 For the cherubim spread out their wings over the place of the ark, and the cherubim covered the ark and its poles above.
9 The poles were so long that the ends of the poles were seen from the ark in front of the inner sanctuary, but they were not seen outside; and it is there to this day.
10 There was nothing in the ark except the two tablets which Moses put there at Horeb, when Yahweh made a covenant with the children of Israel, when they came out of Egypt.
11 When the priests had come out of the holy place (for all the priests who were present had sanctified themselves, and didn't keep their divisions;

† **4:16** "abi" means "his father"

12 also the Levites who were the singers,
all of them, even Asaph, Heman,
Jeduthun, and their sons and their
brothers, arrayed in fine linen, with
cymbals and stringed instruments and
harps, stood at the east end of the altar,
and with them one hundred twenty
priests sounding with trumpets);
13 when the trumpeters and singers
were as one, to make one sound to be
heard in praising and thanking Yahweh;
and when they lifted up their voice with
the trumpets and cymbals and
instruments of music, and praised
Yahweh, saying,
"For he is good,
for his loving kindness endures
forever!"
then the house was filled with a cloud,
even Yahweh's house,
14 so that the priests could not stand to
minister by reason of the cloud; for
Yahweh's glory filled God's house.

6

1 Then Solomon said, "Yahweh has said
that he would dwell in the thick darkness.
2 But I have built you a house and home,
a place for you to dwell in forever."
3 The king turned his face, and blessed
all the assembly of Israel; and all the
assembly of Israel stood.
4 He said, "Blessed be Yahweh, the God
of Israel, who spoke with his mouth to
David my father, and has with his hands
fulfilled it, saying,
5 'Since the day that I brought my people
out of the land of Egypt, I chose no city out
of all the tribes of Israel to build a house
in, that my name might be there, and I
chose no man to be prince over my people
Israel;
6 but now I have chosen Jerusalem, that
my name might be there; and I have
chosen David to be over my people Israel.'
7 Now it was in the heart of David my
father to build a house for the name of
Yahweh, the God of Israel.
8 But Yahweh said to David my father,
'Whereas it was in your heart to build a
house for my name, you did well that it
was in your heart;
9 nevertheless you shall not build the
house, but your son who will come out of
your body, he shall build the house for my
name.'
10 "Yahweh has performed his word
that he spoke; for I have risen up in the
place of David my father, and sit on the
throne of Israel, as Yahweh promised, and
have built the house for the name of
Yahweh, the God of Israel.
11 There I have set the ark, in which is
Yahweh's covenant, which he made with
the children of Israel."
12 He stood before Yahweh's altar in the
presence of all the assembly of Israel, and
spread out his hands
13 (for Solomon had made a bronze
platform, five cubits† long, five cubits
wide, and three cubits high, and had set it
in the middle of the court; and he stood on
it, and knelt down on his knees before all
the assembly of Israel, and spread out his
hands toward heaven).
14 Then he said, "Yahweh, the God of
Israel, there is no God like you in heaven
or on earth—you who keep covenant and
loving kindness with your servants who
walk before you with all their heart;
15 who have kept with your servant
David my father that which you promised
him. Yes, you spoke with your mouth, and
have fulfilled it with your hand, as it is
today.
16 "Now therefore, Yahweh, the God of
Israel, keep with your servant David my
father that which you have promised him,
saying, 'There shall not fail you a man in
my sight to sit on the throne of Israel, if
only your children take heed to their way,
to walk in my law as you have walked
before me.'
17 Now therefore, Yahweh, the God of
Israel, let your word be verified, which
you spoke to your servant David.
18 "But will God indeed dwell with men
on the earth? Behold, heaven and the
heaven of heavens can't contain you; how
much less this house which I have built!

† **6:13** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

19 Yet have respect for the prayer of
your servant and to his supplication,
Yahweh my God, to listen to the cry and to
the prayer which your servant prays
before you;
20 that your eyes may be open toward
this house day and night, even toward the
place where you have said that you would
put your name, to listen to the prayer
which your servant will pray toward this
place.
21 Listen to the petitions of your servant
and of your people Israel, when they pray
toward this place. Yes, hear from your
dwelling place, even from heaven; and
when you hear, forgive.
22 "If a man sins against his neighbor,
and an oath is laid on him to cause him to
swear, and he comes and swears before
your altar in this house,
23 then hear from heaven, act, and judge
your servants, bringing retribution to the
wicked, to bring his way on his own head;
and justifying the righteous, to give him
according to his righteousness.
24 "If your people Israel are struck down
before the enemy because they have
sinned against you, and they turn again
and confess your name, and pray and
make supplication before you in this
house,
25 then hear from heaven, and forgive
the sin of your people Israel, and bring
them again to the land which you gave to
them and to their fathers.
26 "When the sky is shut up and there is
no rain because they have sinned against
you, if they pray toward this place and
confess your name, and turn from their
sin when you afflict them,
27 then hear in heaven, and forgive the
sin of your servants, your people Israel,
when you teach them the good way in
which they should walk, and send rain on
your land, which you have given to your
people for an inheritance.
28 "If there is famine in the land, if there
is pestilence, if there is blight or mildew,
locust or caterpillar; if their enemies
besiege them in the land of their cities;
whatever plague or whatever sickness
there is—
29 whatever prayer and supplication is
made by any man, or by all your people
Israel, who will each know his own plague
and his own sorrow, and shall spread out
his hands toward this house,
30 then hear from heaven your dwelling
place and forgive, and give to every man
according to all his ways, whose heart you
know (for you, even you only, know the
hearts of the children of men),
31 that they may fear you, to walk in
your ways as long as they live in the land
which you gave to our fathers.
32 "Moreover, concerning the foreigner,
who is not of your people Israel, when he
comes from a far country for your great
name's sake and your mighty hand and
your outstretched arm, when they come
and pray toward this house,
33 then hear from heaven, even from
your dwelling place, and do according to
all that the foreigner calls to you for; that
all the peoples of the earth may know
your name and fear you, as do your
people Israel, and that they may know
that this house which I have built is called
by your name.
34 "If your people go out to battle against
their enemies, by whatever way you send
them, and they pray to you toward this
city which you have chosen, and the
house which I have built for your name;
35 then hear from heaven their prayer
and their supplication, and maintain their
cause.
36 "If they sin against you (for there is no
man who doesn't sin), and you are angry
with them and deliver them to the enemy,
so that they carry them away captive to a
land far off or near;
37 yet if they come to their senses in the
land where they are carried captive, and
turn again, and make supplication to you
in the land of their captivity, saying, 'We
have sinned, we have done perversely,
and have dealt wickedly;'
38 if they return to you with all their
heart and with all their soul in the land of
their captivity, where they have been

taken captive, and pray toward their land which you gave to their fathers, and the city which you have chosen, and toward the house which I have built for your name;
39 then hear from heaven, even from your dwelling place, their prayer and their petitions, and maintain their cause, and forgive your people who have sinned against you.
40 "Now, my God, let, I beg you, your eyes be open, and let your ears be attentive to the prayer that is made in this place.
41 "Now therefore arise, Yahweh God, into your resting place, you, and the ark of your strength. Let your priests, Yahweh God, be clothed with salvation, and let your saints rejoice in goodness.
42 "Yahweh God, don't turn away the face of your anointed. Remember your loving kindnesses to David your servant."

7

1 Now when Solomon had finished praying, fire came down from heaven and consumed the burnt offering and the sacrifices; and Yahweh's glory filled the house.
2 The priests could not enter into Yahweh's house, because Yahweh's glory filled Yahweh's house.
3 All the children of Israel looked on, when the fire came down, and Yahweh's glory was on the house. They bowed themselves with their faces to the ground on the pavement, worshiped, and gave thanks to Yahweh, saying,
"For he is good,
for his loving kindness endures forever!"
4 Then the king and all the people offered sacrifices before Yahweh.
5 King Solomon offered a sacrifice of twenty-two thousand head of cattle and a hundred twenty thousand sheep. So the king and all the people dedicated God's house.
6 The priests stood, according to their positions; the Levites also with instruments of music of Yahweh, which David the king had made to give thanks to Yahweh, when David praised by their ministry, saying "For his loving kindness endures forever." The priests sounded trumpets before them; and all Israel stood.
7 Moreover Solomon made the middle of the court that was before Yahweh's house holy; for there he offered the burnt offerings and the fat of the peace offerings, because the bronze altar which Solomon had made was not able to receive the burnt offering, the meal offering, and the fat.
8 So Solomon held the feast at that time for seven days, and all Israel with him, a very great assembly, from the entrance of Hamath to the brook of Egypt.
9 On the eighth day, they held a solemn assembly; for they kept the dedication of the altar seven days, and the feast seven days.
10 On the twenty-third day of the seventh month, he sent the people away to their tents, joyful and glad of heart for the goodness that Yahweh had shown to David, to Solomon, and to Israel his people.
11 Thus Solomon finished Yahweh's house and the king's house; and he successfully completed all that came into Solomon's heart to make in Yahweh's house and in his own house.
12 Then Yahweh appeared to Solomon by night, and said to him, "I have heard your prayer, and have chosen this place for myself for a house of sacrifice.
13 "If I shut up the sky so that there is no rain, or if I command the locust to devour the land, or if I send pestilence among my people,
14 if my people who are called by my name will humble themselves, pray, seek my face, and turn from their wicked ways, then I will hear from heaven, will forgive their sin, and will heal their land.
15 Now my eyes will be open and my ears attentive to prayer that is made in this place.
16 For now I have chosen and made this house holy, that my name may be there forever; and my eyes and my heart will be there perpetually.

17 "As for you, if you will walk before me
as David your father walked, and do
according to all that I have commanded
you, and will keep my statutes and my
ordinances,
18 then I will establish the throne of your
kingdom, according as I covenanted with
David your father, saying, 'There shall not
fail you a man to be ruler in Israel.'
19 But if you turn away and forsake my
statutes and my commandments which I
have set before you, and go and serve
other gods and worship them,
20 then I will pluck them up by the roots
out of my land which I have given them;
and this house, which I have made holy
for my name, I will cast out of my sight,
and I will make it a proverb and a byword
among all peoples.
21 This house, which is so high,
everyone who passes by it will be
astonished and say, 'Why has Yahweh
done this to this land and to this house?'
22 They shall answer, 'Because they
abandoned Yahweh, the God of their
fathers, who brought them out of the land
of Egypt, and took other gods, worshiped
them, and served them. Therefore he has
brought all this evil on them.' "

8

1 At the end of twenty years, in which
Solomon had built Yahweh's house and
his own house,
2 Solomon built the cities which Huram
had given to Solomon, and caused the
children of Israel to dwell there.
3 Solomon went to Hamath Zobah, and
prevailed against it.
4 He built Tadmor in the wilderness,
and all the storage cities, which he built in
Hamath.
5 Also he built Beth Horon the upper
and Beth Horon the lower, fortified cities
with walls, gates, and bars;
6 and Baalath, and all the storage cities
that Solomon had, and all the cities for his
chariots, the cities for his horsemen, and
all that Solomon desired to build for his
pleasure in Jerusalem, in Lebanon, and in
all the land of his dominion.
7 As for all the people who were left of
the Hittites, the Amorites, the Perizzites,
the Hivites, and the Jebusites, who were
not of Israel—
8 of their children who were left after
them in the land, whom the children of
Israel didn't consume—of them Solomon
conscripted forced labor to this day.
9 But of the children of Israel, Solomon
made no servants for his work, but they
were men of war, chief of his captains,
and rulers of his chariots and of his
horsemen.
10 These were the chief officers of King
Solomon, even two-hundred fifty, who
ruled over the people.
11 Solomon brought up Pharaoh's
daughter out of David's city to the house
that he had built for her; for he said, "My
wife shall not dwell in the house of David
king of Israel, because the places where
Yahweh's ark has come are holy."
12 Then Solomon offered burnt
offerings to Yahweh on Yahweh's altar
which he had built before the porch,
13 even as the duty of every day
required, offering according to the
commandment of Moses on the Sabbaths,
on the new moons, and on the set feasts,
three times per year, during the feast of
unleavened bread, during the feast of
weeks, and during the feast of booths.†
14 He appointed, according to the
ordinance of David his father, the
divisions of the priests to their service,
and the Levites to their offices, to praise
and to minister before the priests, as the
duty of every day required, the
doorkeepers also by their divisions at
every gate, for David the man of God had
so commanded.
15 They didn't depart from the
commandment of the king to the priests
and Levites concerning any matter or
concerning the treasures.
16 Now all the work of Solomon was
accomplished from the day of the
foundation of Yahweh's house until it was
finished. So Yahweh's house was
completed.

† **8:13** or, feast of tents (Sukkot)

17 Then Solomon went to Ezion Geber
and to Eloth, on the seashore in the land
of Edom.
18 Huram sent him ships and servants
who had knowledge of the sea by the
hands of his servants; and they came with
the servants of Solomon to Ophir, and
brought from there four hundred fifty
talents‡ of gold, and brought them to King
Solomon.

9

1 When the queen of Sheba heard of the
fame of Solomon, she came to test
Solomon with hard questions at
Jerusalem, with a very great caravan,
including camels that bore spices, gold in
abundance, and precious stones. When
she had come to Solomon, she talked with
him about all that was in her heart.
2 Solomon answered all her questions.
There wasn't anything hidden from
Solomon which he didn't tell her.
3 When the queen of Sheba had seen the
wisdom of Solomon, the house that he had
built,
4 the food of his table, the seating of his
servants, the attendance of his ministers,
their clothing, his cup bearers and their
clothing, and his ascent by which he went
up to Yahweh's house, there was no more
spirit in her.†
5 She said to the king, "It was a true
report that I heard in my own land of your
acts and of your wisdom.
6 However I didn't believe their words
until I came, and my eyes had seen it; and
behold half of the greatness of your
wisdom wasn't told me. You exceed the
fame that I heard!
7 Happy are your men, and happy are
these your servants, who stand
continually before you and hear your
wisdom.
8 Blessed be Yahweh your God, who
delighted in you and set you on his throne
to be king for Yahweh your God, because
your God loved Israel, to establish them
forever. Therefore he made you king over
them, to do justice and righteousness."
9 She gave the king one hundred and
twenty talents‡ of gold, spices in great
abundance, and precious stones. There
was never before such spice as the queen
of Sheba gave to King Solomon.
10 The servants of Huram and the
servants of Solomon, who brought gold
from Ophir, also brought algum trees§
and precious stones.
11 The king used algum tree wood to
make terraces for Yahweh's house and for
the king's house, and harps and stringed
instruments for the singers. There were
none like these seen before in the land of
Judah.
12 King Solomon gave to the queen of
Sheba all her desire, whatever she asked,
more than that which she had brought to
the king. So she turned and went to her
own land, she and her servants.
13 Now the weight of gold that came to
Solomon in one year was six hundred
sixty-six talents† of gold,
14 in addition to that which the traders
and merchants brought. All the kings of
Arabia and the governors of the country
brought gold and silver to Solomon.
15 King Solomon made two hundred
large shields of beaten gold. Six hundred
shekels‡ of beaten gold went to one large
shield.
16 He made three hundred shields of
beaten gold. Three hundred shekels§ of
gold went to one shield. The king put them
in the House of the Forest of Lebanon.
17 Moreover the king made a great
throne of ivory, and overlaid it with pure
gold.
18 There were six steps to the throne,
with a footstool of gold, which were
fastened to the throne, and armrests on

‡ **8:18** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 450 talents is about 13.5 metric tons † **9:4** or, she was breathless. ‡ **9:9** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 120 talents is about 3.6 metric tons § **9:10** possibly Indian sandalwood, which has nice grain and a pleasant scent and is good for woodworking † **9:13** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces, so 666 talents is about 20 metric tons ‡ **9:15** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 600 shekels was about 6 kilograms or about 192 Troy ounces. § **9:16** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.32 Troy ounces, so 300 shekels was about 3 kilograms or about 96 Troy ounces.

either side by the place of the seat, and two lions standing beside the armrests.
19 Twelve lions stood there on the one side and on the other on the six steps. There was nothing like it made in any other kingdom.
20 All King Solomon's drinking vessels were of gold, and all the vessels of the House of the Forest of Lebanon were of pure gold. Silver was not considered valuable in the days of Solomon.
21 For the king had ships that went to Tarshish with Huram's servants. Once every three years, the ships of Tarshish came bringing gold, silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks.
22 So King Solomon exceeded all the kings of the earth in riches and wisdom.
23 All the kings of the earth sought the presence of Solomon to hear his wisdom, which God had put in his heart.
24 They each brought tribute: vessels of silver, vessels of gold, clothing, armor, spices, horses, and mules every year.
25 Solomon had four thousand stalls for horses and chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen that he stationed in the chariot cities and with the king at Jerusalem.
26 He ruled over all the kings from the River even to the land of the Philistines, and to the border of Egypt.
27 The king made silver as common in Jerusalem as stones, and he made cedars to be as abundant as the sycamore trees that are in the lowland.
28 They brought horses for Solomon out of Egypt and out of all lands.
29 Now the rest of the acts of Solomon, first and last, aren't they written in the history of Nathan the prophet, and in the prophecy of Ahijah the Shilonite, and in the visions of Iddo the seer concerning Jeroboam the son of Nebat?
30 Solomon reigned in Jerusalem over all Israel forty years.
31 Solomon slept with his fathers, and he was buried in his father David's city; and Rehoboam his son reigned in his place.

10

1 Rehoboam went to Shechem, for all Israel had come to Shechem to make him king.
2 When Jeroboam the son of Nebat heard of it (for he was in Egypt, where he had fled from the presence of King Solomon), Jeroboam returned out of Egypt.
3 They sent and called him; and Jeroboam and all Israel came, and they spoke to Rehoboam, saying,
4 "Your father made our yoke grievous. Now therefore make the grievous service of your father and his heavy yoke which he put on us, lighter, and we will serve you."
5 He said to them, "Come again to me after three days."
So the people departed.
6 King Rehoboam took counsel with the old men, who had stood before Solomon his father while he yet lived, saying, "What counsel do you give me about how to answer these people?"
7 They spoke to him, saying, "If you are kind to these people, please them, and speak good words to them, then they will be your servants forever."
8 But he abandoned the counsel of the old men which they had given him, and took counsel with the young men who had grown up with him, who stood before him.
9 He said to them, "What counsel do you give, that we may give an answer to these people, who have spoken to me, saying, 'Make the yoke that your father put on us lighter'?"
10 The young men who had grown up with him spoke to him, saying, "Thus you shall tell the people who spoke to you, saying, 'Your father made our yoke heavy, but make it lighter on us;' thus you shall say to them, 'My little finger is thicker than my father's waist.
11 Now whereas my father burdened you with a heavy yoke, I will add to your yoke. My father chastised you with whips, but I will chastise you with scorpions.' "
12 So Jeroboam and all the people came to Rehoboam the third day, as the king asked, saying, "Come to me again the third day."

13 The king answered them roughly;
and King Rehoboam abandoned the
counsel of the old men,
14 and spoke to them after the counsel of
the young men, saying, “My father made
your yoke heavy, but I will add to it. My
father chastised you with whips, but I will
chastise you with scorpions.”
15 So the king didn’t listen to the people;
for it was brought about by God, that
Yahweh might establish his word, which
he spoke by Ahijah the Shilonite to
Jeroboam the son of Nebat.
16 When all Israel saw that the king
didn’t listen to them, the people answered
the king, saying, “What portion do we
have in David? We don’t have an
inheritance in the son of Jesse! Every man
to your tents, Israel! Now see to your own
house, David.” So all Israel departed to
their tents.
17 But as for the children of Israel who
lived in the cities of Judah, Rehoboam
reigned over them.
18 Then King Rehoboam sent Hadoram,
who was over the men subject to forced
labor; and the children of Israel stoned
him to death with stones. King Rehoboam
hurried to get himself up to his chariot, to
flee to Jerusalem.
19 So Israel rebelled against David’s
house to this day.

11

1 When Rehoboam had come to
Jerusalem, he assembled the house of
Judah and Benjamin, one hundred eighty
thousand chosen men who were
warriors, to fight against Israel, to bring
the kingdom again to Rehoboam.
2 But Yahweh’s word came to Shemaiah
the man of God, saying,
3 “Speak to Rehoboam the son of
Solomon, king of Judah, and to all Israel in
Judah and Benjamin, saying,
4 ‘Yahweh says, “You shall not go up, nor
fight against your brothers! Every man
return to his house; for this thing is of
me.” ’ ” So they listened to Yahweh’s
words, and returned from going against
Jeroboam.
5 Rehoboam lived in Jerusalem, and
built cities for defense in Judah.
6 He built Bethlehem, Etam, Tekoa,
7 Beth Zur, Soco, Adullam,
8 Gath, Mareshah, Ziph,
9 Adoraim, Lachish, Azekah,
10 Zorah, Aijalon, and Hebron, which
are fortified cities in Judah and in
Benjamin.
11 He fortified the strongholds and put
captains in them with stores of food, oil
and wine.
12 He put shields and spears in every
city, and made them exceedingly strong.
Judah and Benjamin belonged to him.
13 The priests and the Levites who were
in all Israel stood with him out of all their
territory.
14 For the Levites left their pasture lands
and their possessions, and came to Judah
and Jerusalem; for Jeroboam and his sons
cast them off, that they should not execute
the priest’s office to Yahweh.
15 He himself appointed priests for the
high places, for the male goat and calf
idols which he had made.
16 After them, out of all the tribes of
Israel, those who set their hearts to seek
Yahweh, the God of Israel, came to
Jerusalem to sacrifice to Yahweh, the God
of their fathers.
17 So they strengthened the kingdom of
Judah and made Rehoboam the son of
Solomon strong for three years, for they
walked three years in the way of David
and Solomon.
18 Rehoboam took a wife for himself,
Mahalath the daughter of Jerimoth the
son of David and of Abihail the daughter
of Eliab the son of Jesse.
19 She bore him sons: Jeush, Shemariah,
and Zaham.
20 After her, he took Maacah the
granddaughter of Absalom; and she bore
him Abijah, Attai, Ziza, and Shelomith.
21 Rehoboam loved Maacah the
granddaughter of Absalom above all his
wives and his concubines; for he took
eighteen wives and sixty concubines, and
became the father of twenty-eight sons
and sixty daughters.

22 Rehoboam appointed Abijah the son
of Maacah to be chief, the prince among
his brothers, for he intended to make him
king.
23 He dealt wisely, and dispersed some
of his sons throughout all the lands of
Judah and Benjamin, to every fortified
city. He gave them food in abundance;
and he sought many wives for them.

12

1 When the kingdom of Rehoboam was
established and he was strong, he
abandoned Yahweh's law, and all Israel
with him.
2 In the fifth year of King Rehoboam,
Shishak king of Egypt came up against
Jerusalem, because they had trespassed
against Yahweh,
3 with twelve hundred chariots and
sixty thousand horsemen. The people
were without number who came with
him out of Egypt: the Lubim, the Sukkiim,
and the Ethiopians.
4 He took the fortified cities which
belonged to Judah, and came to Jerusalem.
5 Now Shemaiah the prophet came to
Rehoboam and to the princes of Judah,
who were gathered together to Jerusalem
because of Shishak, and said to them,
"Yahweh says, 'You have forsaken me,
therefore I have also left you in the hand
of Shishak.' "
6 Then the princes of Israel and the king
humbled themselves; and they said,
"Yahweh is righteous."
7 When Yahweh saw that they humbled
themselves, Yahweh's word came to
Shemaiah, saying, "They have humbled
themselves. I will not destroy them, but I
will grant them some deliverance, and my
wrath won't be poured out on Jerusalem
by the hand of Shishak.
8 Nevertheless they will be his servants,
that they may know my service, and the
service of the kingdoms of the countries."
9 So Shishak king of Egypt came up
against Jerusalem and took away the
treasures of Yahweh's house and the
treasures of the king's house. He took it all
away. He also took away the shields of
gold which Solomon had made.
10 King Rehoboam made shields of
bronze in their place, and committed
them to the hands of the captains of the
guard, who kept the door of the king's
house.
11 As often as the king entered into
Yahweh's house, the guard came and bore
them, then brought them back into the
guard room.
12 When he humbled himself, Yahweh's
wrath turned from him, so as not to
destroy him altogether. Moreover, there
were good things found in Judah.
13 So King Rehoboam strengthened
himself in Jerusalem and reigned; for
Rehoboam was forty-one years old when
he began to reign, and he reigned
seventeen years in Jerusalem, the city
which Yahweh had chosen out of all the
tribes of Israel to put his name there. His
mother's name was Naamah the
Ammonitess.
14 He did that which was evil, because
he didn't set his heart to seek Yahweh.
15 Now the acts of Rehoboam, first and
last, aren't they written in the histories of
Shemaiah the prophet and of Iddo the
seer, in the genealogies? There were wars
between Rehoboam and Jeroboam
continually.
16 Rehoboam slept with his fathers, and
was buried in David's city; and Abijah his
son reigned in his place.

13

1 In the eighteenth year of King
Jeroboam, Abijah began to reign over
Judah.
2 He reigned three years in Jerusalem.
His mother's name was Micaiah the
daughter of Uriel of Gibeah. There was
war between Abijah and Jeroboam.
3 Abijah joined battle with an army of
valiant men of war, even four hundred
thousand chosen men; and Jeroboam set
the battle in array against him with eight
hundred thousand chosen men, who were
mighty men of valor.
4 Abijah stood up on Mount Zemaraim,
which is in the hill country of Ephraim,
and said, "Hear me, Jeroboam and all
Israel:

5 Ought you not to know that Yahweh, the God of Israel, gave the kingdom over Israel to David forever, even to him and to his sons by a covenant of salt?
6 Yet Jeroboam the son of Nebat, the servant of Solomon the son of David, rose up, and rebelled against his lord.
7 Worthless men were gathered to him, wicked fellows who strengthened themselves against Rehoboam the son of Solomon, when Rehoboam was young and tender hearted, and could not withstand them.
8 "Now you intend to withstand the kingdom of Yahweh in the hand of the sons of David. You are a great multitude, and the golden calves which Jeroboam made you for gods are with you.
9 Haven't you driven out the priests of Yahweh, the sons of Aaron, and the Levites, and made priests for yourselves according to the ways of the peoples of other lands? Whoever comes to consecrate himself with a young bull and seven rams may be a priest of those who are no gods.
10 "But as for us, Yahweh is our God, and we have not forsaken him. We have priests serving Yahweh, the sons of Aaron, and the Levites in their work.
11 They burn to Yahweh every morning and every evening burnt offerings and sweet incense. They also set the show bread in order on the pure table, and care for the gold lamp stand with its lamps, to burn every evening; for we keep the instruction of Yahweh our God, but you have forsaken him.
12 Behold, God is with us at our head, and his priests with the trumpets of alarm to sound an alarm against you. Children of Israel, don't fight against Yahweh, the God of your fathers; for you will not prosper."
13 But Jeroboam caused an ambush to come about behind them; so they were before Judah, and the ambush was behind them.
14 When Judah looked back, behold, the battle was before and behind them; and they cried to Yahweh, and the priests sounded with the trumpets.
15 Then the men of Judah gave a shout. As the men of Judah shouted, God struck Jeroboam and all Israel before Abijah and Judah.
16 The children of Israel fled before Judah, and God delivered them into their hand.
17 Abijah and his people killed them with a great slaughter, so five hundred thousand chosen men of Israel fell down slain.
18 Thus the children of Israel were brought under at that time, and the children of Judah prevailed, because they relied on Yahweh, the God of their fathers.
19 Abijah pursued Jeroboam, and took cities from him: Bethel with its villages, Jeshanah with its villages, and Ephron with its villages.
20 Jeroboam didn't recover strength again in the days of Abijah. Yahweh struck him, and he died.
21 But Abijah grew mighty and took for himself fourteen wives, and became the father of twenty-two sons and sixteen daughters.
22 The rest of the acts of Abijah, his ways, and his sayings are written in the commentary of the prophet Iddo.

14

1 So Abijah slept with his fathers, and they buried him in David's city; and Asa his son reigned in his place. In his days, the land was quiet ten years.
2 Asa did that which was good and right in Yahweh his God's eyes,
3 for he took away the foreign altars and the high places, broke down the pillars, cut down the Asherah poles,
4 and commanded Judah to seek Yahweh, the God of their fathers, and to obey his law and command.
5 Also he took away out of all the cities of Judah the high places and the sun images; and the kingdom was quiet before him.
6 He built fortified cities in Judah; for the land was quiet, and he had no war in those years, because Yahweh had given him rest.
7 For he said to Judah, "Let's build these cities and make walls around them, with

towers, gates, and bars. The land is yet before us, because we have sought Yahweh our God. We have sought him, and he has given us rest on every side." So they built and prospered.

8 Asa had an army of three hundred thousand out of Judah who bore bucklers and spears, and two hundred eighty thousand out of Benjamin who bore shields and drew bows. All these were mighty men of valor.

9 Zerah the Ethiopian came out against them with an army of a million troops and three hundred chariots, and he came to Mareshah.

10 Then Asa went out to meet him, and they set the battle in array in the valley of Zephathah at Mareshah.

11 Asa cried to Yahweh his God, and said, "Yahweh, there is no one besides you to help, between the mighty and him who has no strength. Help us, Yahweh our God; for we rely on you, and in your name we have come against this multitude. Yahweh, you are our God. Don't let man prevail against you."

12 So Yahweh struck the Ethiopians before Asa and before Judah; and the Ethiopians fled.

13 Asa and the people who were with him pursued them to Gerar. So many of the Ethiopians fell that they could not recover themselves, for they were destroyed before Yahweh and before his army. Judah's army carried away very much booty.

14 They struck all the cities around Gerar, for the fear of Yahweh came on them. They plundered all the cities, for there was much plunder in them.

15 They also struck the tents of those who had livestock, and carried away sheep and camels in abundance, then returned to Jerusalem.

15

1 The Spirit of God came on Azariah the son of Oded.

2 He went out to meet Asa, and said to him, "Hear me, Asa, and all Judah and Benjamin! Yahweh is with you while you are with him; and if you seek him, he will be found by you; but if you forsake him, he will forsake you.

3 Now for a long time Israel was without the true God, without a teaching priest, and without law.

4 But when in their distress they turned to Yahweh, the God of Israel, and sought him, he was found by them.

5 In those times there was no peace to him who went out, nor to him who came in; but great troubles were on all the inhabitants of the lands.

6 They were broken in pieces, nation against nation, and city against city; for God troubled them with all adversity.

7 But you be strong! Don't let your hands be slack, for your work will be rewarded."

8 When Asa heard these words and the prophecy of Oded the prophet, he took courage, and put away the abominations out of all the land of Judah and Benjamin, and out of the cities which he had taken from the hill country of Ephraim; and he renewed Yahweh's altar that was before Yahweh's porch.

9 He gathered all Judah and Benjamin, and those who lived with them out of Ephraim, Manasseh, and Simeon; for they came to him out of Israel in abundance when they saw that Yahweh his God was with him.

10 So they gathered themselves together at Jerusalem in the third month, in the fifteenth year of Asa's reign.

11 They sacrificed to Yahweh in that day, from the plunder which they had brought, seven hundred head of cattle and seven thousand sheep.

12 They entered into the covenant to seek Yahweh, the God of their fathers, with all their heart and with all their soul;

13 and that whoever would not seek Yahweh, the God of Israel, should be put to death, whether small or great, whether man or woman.

14 They swore to Yahweh with a loud voice, with shouting, with trumpets, and with cornets.

15 All Judah rejoiced at the oath, for they had sworn with all their heart and sought him with their whole desire; and he was

found by them. Then Yahweh gave them rest all around.
16 Also Maacah, the mother of Asa the king, he removed from being queen mother, because she had made an abominable image for an Asherah; so Asa cut down her image, ground it into dust, and burned it at the brook Kidron.
17 But the high places were not taken away out of Israel; nevertheless the heart of Asa was perfect all his days.
18 He brought the things that his father had dedicated and that he himself had dedicated, silver, gold, and vessels into God's house.
19 There was no more war to the thirty-fifth year of Asa's reign.

16

1 In the thirty-sixth year of Asa's reign, Baasha king of Israel went up against Judah, and built Ramah, that he might not allow anyone to go out or come in to Asa king of Judah.
2 Then Asa brought out silver and gold out of the treasures of Yahweh's house and of the king's house, and sent to Ben Hadad king of Syria, who lived at Damascus, saying,
3 "Let there be a treaty between me and you, as there was between my father and your father. Behold, I have sent you silver and gold. Go, break your treaty with Baasha king of Israel, that he may depart from me."
4 Ben Hadad listened to King Asa, and sent the captains of his armies against the cities of Israel; and they struck Ijon, Dan, Abel Maim, and all the storage cities of Naphtali.
5 When Baasha heard of it, he stopped building Ramah, and let his work cease.
6 Then Asa the king took all Judah, and they carried away the stones and timber of Ramah, with which Baasha had built; and he built Geba and Mizpah with them.
7 At that time Hanani the seer came to Asa king of Judah, and said to him, "Because you have relied on the king of Syria, and have not relied on Yahweh your God, therefore the army of the king of Syria has escaped out of your hand.
8 Weren't the Ethiopians and the Lubim a huge army, with chariots and exceedingly many horsemen? Yet, because you relied on Yahweh, he delivered them into your hand.
9 For Yahweh's eyes run back and forth throughout the whole earth, to show himself strong in the behalf of them whose heart is perfect toward him. You have done foolishly in this; for from now on you will have wars."
10 Then Asa was angry with the seer, and put him in the prison; for he was in a rage with him because of this thing. Asa oppressed some of the people at the same time.
11 Behold, the acts of Asa, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel.
12 In the thirty-ninth year of his reign, Asa was diseased in his feet. His disease was exceedingly great; yet in his disease he didn't seek Yahweh, but just the physicians.
13 Asa slept with his fathers, and died in the forty-first year of his reign.
14 They buried him in his own tomb, which he had dug out for himself in David's city, and laid him in the bed which was filled with sweet odors and various kinds of spices prepared by the perfumers' art; and they made a very great fire for him.

17

1 Jehoshaphat his son reigned in his place, and strengthened himself against Israel.
2 He placed forces in all the fortified cities of Judah, and set garrisons in the land of Judah and in the cities of Ephraim, which Asa his father had taken.
3 Yahweh was with Jehoshaphat, because he walked in the first ways of his father David, and didn't seek the Baals,
4 but sought the God of his father, and walked in his commandments, and not in the ways of Israel.
5 Therefore Yahweh established the kingdom in his hand. All Judah brought tribute to Jehoshaphat, and he had riches and honor in abundance.

6 His heart was lifted up in the ways of Yahweh. Furthermore, he took away the high places and the Asherah poles out of Judah.

7 Also in the third year of his reign he sent his princes, even Ben Hail, Obadiah, Zechariah, Nethanel, and Micaiah, to teach in the cities of Judah;

8 and with them Levites, even Shemaiah, Nethaniah, Zebadiah, Asahel, Shemiramoth, Jehonathan, Adonijah, Tobijah, and Tobadonijah, the Levites; and with them Elishama and Jehoram, the priests.

9 They taught in Judah, having the book of Yahweh's law with them. They went about throughout all the cities of Judah and taught among the people.

10 The fear of Yahweh fell on all the kingdoms of the lands that were around Judah, so that they made no war against Jehoshaphat.

11 Some of the Philistines brought Jehoshaphat presents and silver for tribute. The Arabians also brought him flocks: seven thousand seven hundred rams and seven thousand seven hundred male goats.

12 Jehoshaphat grew great exceedingly; and he built fortresses and store cities in Judah.

13 He had many works in the cities of Judah; and men of war, mighty men of valor, in Jerusalem.

14 This was the numbering of them according to their fathers' houses: From Judah, the captains of thousands: Adnah the captain, and with him three hundred thousand mighty men of valor;

15 and next to him Jehohanan the captain, and with him two hundred eighty thousand;

16 and next to him Amasiah the son of Zichri, who willingly offered himself to Yahweh, and with him two hundred thousand mighty men of valor.

17 From Benjamin: Eliada, a mighty man of valor, and with him two hundred thousand armed with bow and shield;

18 and next to him Jehozabad, and with him one hundred eighty thousand ready and prepared for war.

19 These were those who waited on the king, in addition to those whom the king put in the fortified cities throughout all Judah.

18

1 Now Jehoshaphat had riches and honor in abundance; and he allied himself with Ahab.

2 After some years, he went down to Ahab to Samaria. Ahab killed sheep and cattle for him in abundance, and for the people who were with him, and moved him to go up with him to Ramoth Gilead.

3 Ahab king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat king of Judah, "Will you go with me to Ramoth Gilead?"

He answered him, "I am as you are, and my people as your people. We will be with you in the war."

4 Jehoshaphat said to the king of Israel, "Please inquire first for Yahweh's word."

5 Then the king of Israel gathered the prophets together, four hundred men, and said to them, "Shall we go to Ramoth Gilead to battle, or shall I forbear?"

They said, "Go up, for God will deliver it into the hand of the king."

6 But Jehoshaphat said, "Isn't there here a prophet of Yahweh besides, that we may inquire of him?"

7 The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, "There is yet one man by whom we may inquire of Yahweh; but I hate him, for he never prophesies good concerning me, but always evil. He is Micaiah the son of Imla."

Jehoshaphat said, "Don't let the king say so."

8 Then the king of Israel called an officer, and said, "Get Micaiah the son of Imla quickly."

9 Now the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah each sat on his throne, arrayed in their robes, and they were sitting in an open place at the entrance of the gate of Samaria; and all the prophets were prophesying before them.

10 Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah made himself horns of iron and said, "Yahweh

says, ‘With these you shall push the Syrians, until they are consumed.’ ”
11 All the prophets prophesied so, saying, “Go up to Ramoth Gilead, and prosper; for Yahweh will deliver it into the hand of the king.”
12 The messenger who went to call Micaiah spoke to him, saying, “Behold, the words of the prophets declare good to the king with one mouth. Let your word therefore, please be like one of theirs, and speak good.”
13 Micaiah said, “As Yahweh lives, I will say what my God says.”
14 When he had come to the king, the king said to him, “Micaiah, shall we go to Ramoth Gilead to battle, or shall I forbear?”
He said, “Go up, and prosper. They shall be delivered into your hand.”
15 The king said to him, “How many times shall I adjure you that you speak to me nothing but the truth in Yahweh’s name?”
16 He said, “I saw all Israel scattered on the mountains, as sheep that have no shepherd. Yahweh said, ‘These have no master. Let them each return to his house in peace.’ ”
17 The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, “Didn’t I tell you that he would not prophesy good concerning me, but evil?”
18 Micaiah said, “Therefore hear Yahweh’s word: I saw Yahweh sitting on his throne, and all the army of heaven standing on his right hand and on his left.
19 Yahweh said, ‘Who will entice Ahab king of Israel, that he may go up and fall at Ramoth Gilead?’ One spoke saying in this way, and another saying in that way.
20 A spirit came out, stood before Yahweh, and said, ‘I will entice him.’
“Yahweh said to him, ‘How?’
21 “He said, ‘I will go, and will be a lying spirit in the mouth of all his prophets.’
“He said, ‘You will entice him, and will prevail also. Go and do so.’
22 “Now therefore, behold, Yahweh has put a lying spirit in the mouth of these your prophets; and Yahweh has spoken evil concerning you.”
23 Then Zedekiah the son of Chenaanah came near, and struck Micaiah on the cheek, and said, “Which way did Yahweh’s Spirit go from me to speak to you?”
24 Micaiah said, “Behold, you shall see on that day, when you go into an inner room to hide yourself.”
25 The king of Israel said, “Take Micaiah, and carry him back to Amon the governor of the city, and to Joash the king’s son;
26 and say, ‘The king says, “Put this fellow in the prison, and feed him with bread of affliction and with water of affliction, until I return in peace.” ’ ”
27 Micaiah said, “If you return at all in peace, Yahweh has not spoken by me.” He said, “Listen, you people, all of you!”
28 So the king of Israel and Jehoshaphat the king of Judah went up to Ramoth Gilead.
29 The king of Israel said to Jehoshaphat, “I will disguise myself, and go into the battle; but you put on your robes.” So the king of Israel disguised himself; and they went into the battle.
30 Now the king of Syria had commanded the captains of his chariots, saying, “Don’t fight with small nor great, except only with the king of Israel.”
31 When the captains of the chariots saw Jehoshaphat, they said, “It is the king of Israel!” Therefore they turned around to fight against him. But Jehoshaphat cried out, and Yahweh helped him; and God moved them to depart from him.
32 When the captains of the chariots saw that it was not the king of Israel, they turned back from pursuing him.
33 A certain man drew his bow at random, and struck the king of Israel between the joints of the armor. Therefore he said to the driver of the chariot, “Turn around and carry me out of the battle, for I am severely wounded.”
34 The battle increased that day. However, the king of Israel propped himself up in his chariot against the Syrians until the evening; and at about sunset, he died.

19

1 Jehoshaphat the king of Judah
returned to his house in peace to
Jerusalem.
2 Jehu the son of Hanani the seer went
out to meet him, and said to King
Jehoshaphat, “Should you help the
wicked, and love those who hate Yahweh?
Because of this, wrath is on you from
before Yahweh.
3 Nevertheless there are good things
found in you, in that you have put away
the Asheroth out of the land, and have set
your heart to seek God.”
4 Jehoshaphat lived at Jerusalem; and
he went out again among the people from
Beersheba to the hill country of Ephraim,
and brought them back to Yahweh, the
God of their fathers.
5 He set judges in the land throughout
all the fortified cities of Judah, city by city,
6 and said to the judges, “Consider what
you do, for you don’t judge for man, but
for Yahweh; and he is with you in the
judgment.
7 Now therefore let the fear of Yahweh
be on you. Take heed and do it; for there is
no iniquity with Yahweh our God, nor
respect of persons, nor taking of bribes.”
8 Moreover in Jerusalem Jehoshaphat
appointed certain Levites, priests, and
heads of the fathers’ households of Israel
to give judgment for Yahweh and for
controversies. They returned to
Jerusalem.
9 He commanded them, saying, “You
shall do this in the fear of Yahweh,
faithfully, and with a perfect heart.
10 Whenever any controversy comes to
you from your brothers who dwell in their
cities, between blood and blood, between
law and commandment, statutes and
ordinances, you must warn them, that
they not be guilty toward Yahweh, and so
wrath come on you and on your brothers.
Do this, and you will not be guilty.
11 Behold, Amariah the chief priest is
over you in all matters of Yahweh; and
Zebadiah the son of Ishmael, the ruler of
the house of Judah, in all the king’s
matters. Also the Levites shall be officers
before you. Deal courageously, and may
Yahweh be with the good.”

20

1 After this, the children of Moab, the
children of Ammon, and with them some
of the Meunites†, came against
Jehoshaphat to battle.
2 Then some came who told
Jehoshaphat, saying, “A great multitude is
coming against you from beyond the sea
from Syria. Behold, they are in Hazazon
Tamar” (that is, En Gedi).
3 Jehoshaphat was alarmed, and set
himself to seek Yahweh. He proclaimed a
fast throughout all Judah.
4 Judah gathered themselves together to
seek help from Yahweh. They came out of
all the cities of Judah to seek Yahweh.
5 Jehoshaphat stood in the assembly of
Judah and Jerusalem, in Yahweh’s house,
before the new court;
6 and he said, “Yahweh, the God of our
fathers, aren’t you God in heaven? Aren’t
you ruler over all the kingdoms of the
nations? Power and might are in your
hand, so that no one is able to withstand
you.
7 Didn’t you, our God, drive out the
inhabitants of this land before your
people Israel, and give it to the offspring‡
of Abraham your friend forever?
8 They lived in it, and have built you a
sanctuary in it for your name, saying,
9 ‘If evil comes on us—the sword,
judgment, pestilence, or famine—we will
stand before this house, and before you
(for your name is in this house), and cry to
you in our affliction, and you will hear
and save.’
10 Now, behold, the children of Ammon
and Moab and Mount Seir, whom you
would not let Israel invade when they
came out of the land of Egypt, but they
turned away from them, and didn’t
destroy them;
11 behold, how they reward us, to come
to cast us out of your possession, which
you have given us to inherit.

† **20:1** The LXX reads *Meunites*. Heb. reads *Ammonites*.

‡ **20:7** or, seed

12 Our God, will you not judge them? For
we have no might against this great
company that comes against us. We don't
know what to do, but our eyes are on you."
13 All Judah stood before Yahweh, with
their little ones, their wives, and their
children.
14 Then Yahweh's Spirit came on
Jahaziel the son of Zechariah, the son of
Benaiah, the son of Jeiel, the son of
Mattaniah, the Levite, of the sons of
Asaph, in the middle of the assembly;
15 and he said, "Listen, all Judah, and
you inhabitants of Jerusalem, and you,
King Jehoshaphat. Yahweh says to you,
'Don't be afraid, and don't be dismayed
because of this great multitude; for the
battle is not yours, but God's.
16 Tomorrow, go down against them.
Behold, they are coming up by the ascent
of Ziz. You will find them at the end of the
valley, before the wilderness of Jeruel.
17 You will not need to fight this battle.
Set yourselves, stand still, and see the
salvation of Yahweh with you, O Judah
and Jerusalem. Don't be afraid, nor be
dismayed. Go out against them tomorrow,
for Yahweh is with you.' "
18 Jehoshaphat bowed his head with his
face to the ground; and all Judah and the
inhabitants of Jerusalem fell down before
Yahweh, worshiping Yahweh.
19 The Levites, of the children of the
Kohathites and of the children of the
Korahites, stood up to praise Yahweh, the
God of Israel, with an exceedingly loud
voice.
20 They rose early in the morning and
went out into the wilderness of Tekoa. As
they went out, Jehoshaphat stood and
said, "Listen to me, Judah and you
inhabitants of Jerusalem! Believe in
Yahweh your God, so you will be
established! Believe his prophets, so you
will prosper."
21 When he had taken counsel with the
people, he appointed those who were to
sing to Yahweh and give praise in holy
array as they go out before the army, and
say, "Give thanks to Yahweh, for his loving
kindness endures forever."
22 When they began to sing and to
praise, Yahweh set ambushers against the
children of Ammon, Moab, and Mount
Seir, who had come against Judah; and
they were struck.
23 For the children of Ammon and Moab
stood up against the inhabitants of Mount
Seir to utterly kill and destroy them.
When they had finished the inhabitants of
Seir, everyone helped to destroy each
other.
24 When Judah came to the place
overlooking the wilderness, they looked
at the multitude; and behold, they were
dead bodies fallen to the earth, and there
were none who escaped.
25 When Jehoshaphat and his people
came to take their plunder, they found
among them in abundance both riches
and dead bodies with precious jewels,
which they stripped off for themselves,
more than they could carry away. They
took plunder for three days, it was so
much.
26 On the fourth day, they assembled
themselves in Beracah§ Valley, for there
they blessed Yahweh. Therefore the name
of that place was called "Beracah Valley"
to this day.
27 Then they returned, every man of
Judah and Jerusalem, with Jehoshaphat in
front of them, to go again to Jerusalem
with joy; for Yahweh had made them to
rejoice over their enemies.
28 They came to Jerusalem with stringed
instruments, harps, and trumpets to
Yahweh's house.
29 The fear of God was on all the
kingdoms of the countries when they
heard that Yahweh fought against the
enemies of Israel.
30 So the realm of Jehoshaphat was
quiet, for his God gave him rest all around.
31 So Jehoshaphat reigned over Judah.
He was thirty-five years old when he
began to reign. He reigned twenty-five
years in Jerusalem. His mother's name
was Azubah the daughter of Shilhi.

§ **20:26** "Beracah" means "blessing".

32 He walked in the way of Asa his
father, and didn't turn away from it, doing
that which was right in Yahweh's eyes.
33 However the high places were not
taken away, and the people had still not
set their hearts on the God of their fathers.
34 Now the rest of the acts of
Jehoshaphat, first and last, behold, they
are written in the history of Jehu the son
of Hanani, which is included in the book
of the kings of Israel.
35 After this, Jehoshaphat king of Judah
joined himself with Ahaziah king of Israel.
The same did very wickedly.
36 He joined himself with him to make
ships to go to Tarshish. They made the
ships in Ezion Geber.
37 Then Eliezer the son of Dodavahu of
Mareshah prophesied against
Jehoshaphat, saying, "Because you have
joined yourself with Ahaziah, Yahweh has
destroyed your works." The ships were
wrecked, so that they were not able to go
to Tarshish.

21

1 Jehoshaphat slept with his fathers, and
was buried with his fathers in David's city;
and Jehoram his son reigned in his place.
2 He had brothers, the sons of
Jehoshaphat: Azariah, Jehiel, Zechariah,
Azariah, Michael, and Shephatiah. All
these were the sons of Jehoshaphat king
of Israel.
3 Their father gave them great gifts of
silver, of gold, and of precious things, with
fortified cities in Judah; but he gave the
kingdom to Jehoram, because he was the
firstborn.
4 Now when Jehoram had risen up over
the kingdom of his father, and had
strengthened himself, he killed all his
brothers with the sword, and also some of
the princes of Israel.
5 Jehoram was thirty-two years old
when he began to reign, and he reigned
eight years in Jerusalem.
6 He walked in the way of the kings of
Israel, as did Ahab's house, for he had
Ahab's daughter as his wife. He did that
which was evil in Yahweh's sight.
7 However Yahweh would not destroy
David's house, because of the covenant
that he had made with David, and as he
promised to give a lamp to him and to his
children always.
8 In his days Edom revolted from under
the hand of Judah, and made a king over
themselves.
9 Then Jehoram went there with his
captains and all his chariots with him. He
rose up by night and struck the Edomites
who surrounded him, along with the
captains of the chariots.
10 So Edom has been in revolt from
under the hand of Judah to this day. Then
Libnah revolted at the same time from
under his hand, because he had forsaken
Yahweh, the God of his fathers.
11 Moreover he made high places in the
mountains of Judah, and made the
inhabitants of Jerusalem play the
prostitute, and led Judah astray.
12 A letter came to him from Elijah the
prophet, saying, "Yahweh, the God of
David your father, says, 'Because you
have not walked in the ways of
Jehoshaphat your father, nor in the ways
of Asa king of Judah,
13 but have walked in the way of the
kings of Israel, and have made Judah and
the inhabitants of Jerusalem to play the
prostitute like Ahab's house did, and also
have slain your brothers of your father's
house, who were better than yourself,
14 behold, Yahweh will strike your
people with a great plague, including your
children, your wives, and all your
possessions;
15 and you will have great sickness with
a disease of your bowels, until your
bowels fall out by reason of the sickness,
day by day.' "
16 Yahweh stirred up against Jehoram
the spirit of the Philistines and of the
Arabians who are beside the Ethiopians;
17 and they came up against Judah,
broke into it, and carried away all the
possessions that were found in the king's
house, including his sons and his wives, so
that there was no son left to him except
Jehoahaz, the youngest of his sons.

18 After all this Yahweh struck him in
his bowels with an incurable disease.
19 In process of time, at the end of two
years, his bowels fell out by reason of his
sickness, and he died of severe diseases.
His people made no burning for him, like
the burning of his fathers.
20 He was thirty-two years old when he
began to reign, and he reigned in
Jerusalem eight years. He departed with
no one's regret. They buried him in
David's city, but not in the tombs of the
kings.

22

1 The inhabitants of Jerusalem made
Ahaziah his youngest son king in his
place, because the band of men who came
with the Arabians to the camp had slain
all the oldest. So Ahaziah the son of
Jehoram king of Judah reigned.
2 Ahaziah was forty-two years old when
he began to reign, and he reigned one
year in Jerusalem. His mother's name was
Athaliah the daughter of Omri.
3 He also walked in the ways of Ahab's
house, because his mother was his
counselor in acting wickedly.
4 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's
sight, as did Ahab's house, for they were
his counselors after the death of his
father, to his destruction.
5 He also followed their counsel, and
went with Jehoram the son of Ahab king
of Israel to war against Hazael king of
Syria at Ramoth Gilead; and the Syrians
wounded Joram.
6 He returned to be healed in Jezreel of
the wounds which they had given him at
Ramah, when he fought against Hazael
king of Syria. Azariah the son of Jehoram,
king of Judah, went down to see Jehoram
the son of Ahab in Jezreel, because he was
sick.
7 Now the destruction of Ahaziah was of
God, in that he went to Joram; for when he
had come, he went out with Jehoram
against Jehu the son of Nimshi, whom
Yahweh had anointed to cut off Ahab's
house.
8 When Jehu was executing judgment
on Ahab's house, he found the princes of
Judah and the sons of the brothers of
Ahaziah serving Ahaziah, and killed them.
9 He sought Ahaziah, and they caught
him (now he was hiding in Samaria), and
they brought him to Jehu and killed him;
and they buried him, for they said, "He is
the son of Jehoshaphat, who sought
Yahweh with all his heart." The house of
Ahaziah had no power to hold the
kingdom.
10 Now when Athaliah the mother of
Ahaziah saw that her son was dead, she
arose and destroyed all the royal offspring
of the house of Judah.
11 But Jehoshabeath, the king's
daughter, took Joash the son of Ahaziah,
and stealthily rescued him from among
the king's sons who were slain, and put
him and his nurse in the bedroom. So
Jehoshabeath, the daughter of King
Jehoram, the wife of Jehoiada the priest
(for she was the sister of Ahaziah), hid him
from Athaliah, so that she didn't kill him.
12 He was with them hidden in God's
house six years while Athaliah reigned
over the land.

23

1 In the seventh year, Jehoiada
strengthened himself, and took the
captains of hundreds—Azariah the son of
Jeroham, Ishmael the son of Jehohanan,
Azariah the son of Obed, Maaseiah the
son of Adaiah, and Elishaphat the son of
Zichri—into a covenant with him.
2 They went around in Judah and
gathered the Levites out of all the cities of
Judah, and the heads of fathers'
households of Israel, and they came to
Jerusalem.
3 All the assembly made a covenant
with the king in God's house. Jehoiada†
said to them, "Behold, the king's son must
reign, as Yahweh has spoken concerning
the sons of David.
4 This is the thing that you must do: a
third part of you, who come in on the
Sabbath, of the priests and of the Levites,
shall be gatekeepers of the thresholds.

† **23:3** Hebrew *He*

5 A third part shall be at the king's
house; and a third part at the gate of the
foundation. All the people will be in the
courts of Yahweh's house.
6 But let no one come into Yahweh's
house except the priests and those who
minister of the Levites. They shall come
in, for they are holy, but all the people
shall follow Yahweh's instructions.
7 The Levites shall surround the king,
every man with his weapons in his hand.
Whoever comes into the house, let him be
slain. Be with the king when he comes in
and when he goes out."

8 So the Levites and all Judah did
according to all that Jehoiada the priest
commanded. They each took his men,
those who were to come in on the
Sabbath, with those who were to go out on
the Sabbath, for Jehoiada the priest didn't
dismiss the shift.
9 Jehoiada the priest delivered to the
captains of hundreds the spears, bucklers,
and shields that had been king David's,
which were in God's house.
10 He set all the people, every man with
his weapon in his hand, from the right
side of the house to the left side of the
house, near the altar and the house,
around the king.
11 Then they brought out the king's son,
put the crown on him, gave him the
covenant, and made him king. Jehoiada
and his sons anointed him, and they said,
"Long live the king!"

12 When Athaliah heard the noise of the
people running and praising the king, she
came to the people into Yahweh's house.
13 Then she looked, and behold, the king
stood by his pillar at the entrance, with
the captains and the trumpeters by the
king. All the people of the land rejoiced
and blew trumpets. The singers also
played musical instruments, and led the
singing of praise. Then Athaliah tore her
clothes, and said, "Treason! treason!"

14 Jehoiada the priest brought out the
captains of hundreds who were set over
the army, and said to them, "Bring her out
between the ranks; and whoever follows
her, let him be slain with the sword." For
the priest said, "Don't kill her in Yahweh's
house."
15 So they made way for her. She went
to the entrance of the horse gate to the
king's house; and they killed her there.

16 Jehoiada made a covenant between
himself, all the people, and the king, that
they should be Yahweh's people.
17 All the people went to the house of
Baal, broke it down, broke his altars and
his images in pieces, and killed Mattan the
priest of Baal before the altars.
18 Jehoiada appointed the officers of
Yahweh's house under the hand of the
Levitical priests, whom David had
distributed in Yahweh's house, to offer the
burnt offerings of Yahweh, as it is written
in the law of Moses, with rejoicing and
with singing, as David had ordered.
19 He set the gatekeepers at the gates of
Yahweh's house, that no one who was
unclean in anything should enter in.
20 He took the captains of hundreds, the
nobles, the governors of the people, and
all the people of the land, and brought the
king down from Yahweh's house. They
came through the upper gate to the king's
house, and set the king on the throne of
the kingdom.
21 So all the people of the land rejoiced,
and the city was quiet. They had slain
Athaliah with the sword.

24

1 Joash was seven years old when he
began to reign, and he reigned forty years
in Jerusalem. His mother's name was
Zibiah, of Beersheba.
2 Joash did that which was right in
Yahweh's eyes all the days of Jehoiada the
priest.
3 Jehoiada took for him two wives, and
he became the father of sons and
daughters.
4 After this, Joash intended to restore
Yahweh's house.
5 He gathered together the priests and
the Levites, and said to them, "Go out to
the cities of Judah, and gather money to
repair the house of your God from all
Israel from year to year. See that you

expedite this matter." However the Levites didn't do it right away.
6 The king called for Jehoiada the chief, and said to him, "Why haven't you required of the Levites to bring in the tax of Moses the servant of Yahweh, and of the assembly of Israel, out of Judah and out of Jerusalem, for the Tent of the Testimony?"
7 For the sons of Athaliah, that wicked woman, had broken up God's house; and they also gave all the dedicated things of Yahweh's house to the Baals.
8 So the king commanded, and they made a chest, and set it outside at the gate of Yahweh's house.
9 They made a proclamation through Judah and Jerusalem, to bring in for Yahweh the tax that Moses the servant of God laid on Israel in the wilderness.
10 All the princes and all the people rejoiced, and brought in, and cast into the chest, until they had filled it.
11 Whenever the chest was brought to the king's officers by the hand of the Levites, and when they saw that there was much money, the king's scribe and the chief priest's officer came and emptied the chest, and took it, and carried it to its place again. Thus they did day by day, and gathered money in abundance.
12 The king and Jehoiada gave it to those who did the work of the service of Yahweh's house. They hired masons and carpenters to restore Yahweh's house, and also those who worked iron and bronze to repair Yahweh's house.
13 So the workmen worked, and the work of repairing went forward in their hands. They set up God's house as it was designed, and strengthened it.
14 When they had finished, they brought the rest of the money before the king and Jehoiada, from which were made vessels for Yahweh's house, even vessels with which to minister and to offer, including spoons and vessels of gold and silver. They offered burnt offerings in Yahweh's house continually all the days of Jehoiada.
15 But Jehoiada grew old and was full of days, and he died. He was one hundred thirty years old when he died.
16 They buried him in David's city among the kings, because he had done good in Israel, and toward God and his house.
17 Now after the death of Jehoiada, the princes of Judah came and bowed down to the king. Then the king listened to them.
18 They abandoned the house of Yahweh, the God of their fathers, and served the Asherah poles and the idols, so wrath came on Judah and Jerusalem for this their guiltiness.
19 Yet he sent prophets to them to bring them again to Yahweh, and they testified against them; but they would not listen.
20 The Spirit of God came on Zechariah the son of Jehoiada the priest; and he stood above the people, and said to them, "God says, 'Why do you disobey Yahweh's commandments, so that you can't prosper? Because you have forsaken Yahweh, he has also forsaken you.' "
21 They conspired against him, and stoned him with stones at the commandment of the king in the court of Yahweh's house.
22 Thus Joash the king didn't remember the kindness which Jehoiada his father had done to him, but killed his son. When he died, he said, "May Yahweh look at it, and repay it."
23 At the end of the year, the army of the Syrians came up against him. They came to Judah and Jerusalem, and destroyed all the princes of the people from among the people, and sent all their plunder to the king of Damascus.
24 For the army of the Syrians came with a small company of men; and Yahweh delivered a very great army into their hand, because they had forsaken Yahweh, the God of their fathers. So they executed judgment on Joash.
25 When they had departed from him (for they left him seriously wounded), his own servants conspired against him for the blood of the sons of Jehoiada the priest, and killed him on his bed, and he died. They buried him in David's city, but they didn't bury him in the tombs of the kings.

26 These are those who conspired
against him: Zabad the son of Shimeath
the Ammonitess and Jehozabad the son of
Shimrith the Moabitess.
27 Now concerning his sons, the
greatness of the burdens laid on him, and
the rebuilding of God's house, behold,
they are written in the commentary of the
book of the kings. Amaziah his son
reigned in his place.

25

1 Amaziah was twenty-five years old
when he began to reign, and he reigned
twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His
mother's name was Jehoaddan, of
Jerusalem.
2 He did that which was right in
Yahweh's eyes, but not with a perfect
heart.
3 Now when the kingdom was
established to him, he killed his servants
who had killed his father the king.
4 But he didn't put their children to
death, but did according to that which is
written in the law in the book of Moses, as
Yahweh commanded, saying, "The fathers
shall not die for the children, neither shall
the children die for the fathers; but every
man shall die for his own sin."
5 Moreover Amaziah gathered Judah
together and ordered them according to
their fathers' houses, under captains of
thousands and captains of hundreds,
even all Judah and Benjamin. He counted
them from twenty years old and upward,
and found that there were three hundred
thousand chosen men, able to go out to
war, who could handle spear and shield.
6 He also hired one hundred thousand
mighty men of valor out of Israel for one
hundred talents† of silver.
7 A man of God came to him, saying, "O
king, don't let the army of Israel go with
you, for Yahweh is not with Israel, with all
the children of Ephraim.
8 But if you will go, take action, and be
strong for the battle. God will overthrow
you before the enemy; for God has power
to help, and to overthrow."
9 Amaziah said to the man of God, "But
what shall we do for the hundred talents‡
which I have given to the army of Israel?"
The man of God answered, "Yahweh is
able to give you much more than this."
10 Then Amaziah separated them, the
army that had come to him out of
Ephraim, to go home again. Therefore
their anger was greatly kindled against
Judah, and they returned home in fierce
anger.
11 Amaziah took courage, and led his
people out and went to the Valley of Salt,
and struck ten thousand of the children of
Seir.
12 The children of Judah carried away
ten thousand alive, and brought them to
the top of the rock, and threw them down
from the top of the rock, so that they all
were broken in pieces.
13 But the men of the army whom
Amaziah sent back, that they should not
go with him to battle, fell on the cities of
Judah from Samaria even to Beth Horon,
and struck of them three thousand, and
took much plunder.
14 Now after Amaziah had come from
the slaughter of the Edomites, he brought
the gods of the children of Seir, and set
them up to be his gods, and bowed down
himself before them and burned incense
to them.
15 Therefore Yahweh's anger burned
against Amaziah, and he sent to him a
prophet who said to him, "Why have you
sought after the gods of the people, which
have not delivered their own people out
of your hand?"
16 As he talked with him, the king said to
him, "Have we made you one of the king's
counselors? Stop! Why should you be
struck down?"
Then the prophet stopped, and said, "I
know that God has determined to destroy
you, because you have done this and have
not listened to my counsel."
17 Then Amaziah king of Judah
consulted his advisers, and sent to Joash,
the son of Jehoahaz, the son of Jehu, king

† **25:6** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds ‡ **25:9** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds

of Israel, saying, “Come! Let’s look one another in the face.”
18 Joash king of Israel sent to Amaziah king of Judah, saying, “The thistle that was in Lebanon sent to the cedar that was in Lebanon, saying, ‘Give your daughter to my son as his wife. Then a wild animal that was in Lebanon passed by and trampled down the thistle.
19 You say to yourself that you have struck Edom; and your heart lifts you up to boast. Now stay at home. Why should you meddle with trouble, that you should fall, even you and Judah with you?’ ”
20 But Amaziah would not listen; for it was of God, that he might deliver them into the hand of their enemies, because they had sought after the gods of Edom.
21 So Joash king of Israel went up, and he and Amaziah king of Judah looked one another in the face at Beth Shemesh, which belongs to Judah.
22 Judah was defeated by Israel; so every man fled to his tent.
23 Joash king of Israel took Amaziah king of Judah, the son of Joash the son of Jehoahaz, at Beth Shemesh and brought him to Jerusalem, and broke down the wall of Jerusalem from the gate of Ephraim to the corner gate, four hundred cubits.§
24 He took all the gold and silver, and all the vessels that were found in God’s house with Obed-Edom, and the treasures of the king’s house, and the hostages, and returned to Samaria.
25 Amaziah the son of Joash, king of Judah, lived for fifteen years after the death of Joash, son of Jehoahaz, king of Israel.
26 Now the rest of the acts of Amaziah, first and last, behold, aren’t they written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel?
27 Now from the time that Amaziah turned away from following Yahweh, they made a conspiracy against him in Jerusalem. He fled to Lachish, but they sent after him to Lachish and killed him there.
28 They brought him on horses and buried him with his fathers in the City of Judah.

26

1 All the people of Judah took Uzziah, who was sixteen years old, and made him king in the place of his father Amaziah.
2 He built Eloth and restored it to Judah. After that the king slept with his fathers.
3 Uzziah was sixteen years old when he began to reign; and he reigned fifty-two years in Jerusalem. His mother’s name was Jechiliah, of Jerusalem.
4 He did that which was right in Yahweh’s eyes, according to all that his father Amaziah had done.
5 He set himself to seek God in the days of Zechariah, who had understanding in the vision of God; and as long as he sought Yahweh, God made him prosper.
6 He went out and fought against the Philistines, and broke down the wall of Gath, the wall of Jabneh, and the wall of Ashdod; and he built cities in the country of Ashdod, and among the Philistines.
7 God helped him against the Philistines, and against the Arabians who lived in Gur Baal, and the Meunim.
8 The Ammonites gave tribute to Uzziah. His name spread abroad even to the entrance of Egypt, for he grew exceedingly strong.
9 Moreover Uzziah built towers in Jerusalem at the corner gate, at the valley gate, and at the turning of the wall, and fortified them.
10 He built towers in the wilderness, and dug out many cisterns, for he had much livestock, both in the lowlands and in the plains. He had farmers and vineyard keepers in the mountains and in the fruitful fields, for he loved farming.
11 Moreover Uzziah had an army of fighting men who went out to war by bands, according to the number of their reckoning made by Jeiel the scribe and Maaseiah the officer, under the hand of Hananiah, one of the king’s captains.

§ **25:23** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters, so 400 cubits is about 200 yards or 184 meters.

12 The whole number of the heads of
fathers' households, even the mighty men
of valor, was two thousand six hundred.
13 Under their hand was an army, three
hundred seven thousand five hundred,
who made war with mighty power, to
help the king against the enemy.
14 Uzziah prepared for them, even for all
the army, shields, spears, helmets, coats of
mail, bows, and stones for slinging.
15 In Jerusalem, he made devices,
invented by skillful men, to be on the
towers and on the battlements, with
which to shoot arrows and great stones.
His name spread far abroad, because he
was marvelously helped until he was
strong.

16 But when he was strong, his heart
was lifted up, so that he did corruptly and
he trespassed against Yahweh his God, for
he went into Yahweh's temple to burn
incense on the altar of incense.
17 Azariah the priest went in after him,
and with him eighty priests of Yahweh,
who were valiant men.
18 They resisted Uzziah the king, and
said to him, "It isn't for you, Uzziah, to
burn incense to Yahweh, but for the
priests the sons of Aaron, who are
consecrated to burn incense. Go out of the
sanctuary, for you have trespassed. It will
not be for your honor from Yahweh God."

19 Then Uzziah was angry. He had a
censer in his hand to burn incense, and
while he was angry with the priests, the
leprosy broke out on his forehead before
the priests in Yahweh's house, beside the
altar of incense.
20 Azariah the chief priest and all the
priests looked at him, and behold, he was
leprous in his forehead; and they thrust
him out quickly from there. Indeed, he
himself also hurried to go out, because
Yahweh had struck him.
21 Uzziah the king was a leper to the day
of his death, and lived in a separate house,
being a leper; for he was cut off from
Yahweh's house. Jotham his son was over
the king's house, judging the people of the
land.
22 Now the rest of the acts of Uzziah,
first and last, Isaiah the prophet, the son
of Amoz, wrote.
23 So Uzziah slept with his fathers; and
they buried him with his fathers in the
field of burial which belonged to the
kings, for they said, "He is a leper."
Jotham his son reigned in his place.

27

1 Jotham was twenty-five years old
when he began to reign, and he reigned
sixteen years in Jerusalem. His mother's
name was Jerushah the daughter of
Zadok.
2 He did that which was right in
Yahweh's eyes, according to all that his
father Uzziah had done. However he
didn't enter into Yahweh's temple. The
people still acted corruptly.
3 He built the upper gate of Yahweh's
house, and he built much on the wall of
Ophel.
4 Moreover he built cities in the hill
country of Judah, and in the forests he
built fortresses and towers.
5 He also fought with the king of the
children of Ammon, and prevailed against
them. The children of Ammon gave him
the same year one hundred talents† of
silver, ten thousand cors‡ of wheat, and
ten thousand cors of barley.§ The
children of Ammon also gave that much
to him in the second year, and in the third.
6 So Jotham became mighty, because he
ordered his ways before Yahweh his God.
7 Now the rest of the acts of Jotham, and
all his wars and his ways, behold, they are
written in the book of the kings of Israel
and Judah.
8 He was twenty-five years old when he
began to reign, and reigned sixteen years
in Jerusalem.
9 Jotham slept with his fathers, and they
buried him in David's city; and Ahaz his
son reigned in his place.

† **27:5** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds ‡ **27:5** 1 cor is the same as a homer, or about 55.9 U. S. gallons (liquid) or 211 liters or 6 bushels. 10,000 cors of wheat would weigh about 1,640 metric tons. § **27:5** 10,000 cors of barley would weigh about 1,310 metric tons.

28

1 Ahaz was twenty years old when he
began to reign, and he reigned sixteen
years in Jerusalem. He didn't do that
which was right in Yahweh's eyes, like
David his father,
2 but he walked in the ways of the kings
of Israel, and also made molten images for
the Baals.
3 Moreover he burned incense in the
valley of the son of Hinnom, and burned
his children in the fire, according to the
abominations of the nations whom
Yahweh cast out before the children of
Israel.
4 He sacrificed and burned incense in
the high places, and on the hills, and
under every green tree.

5 Therefore Yahweh his God delivered
him into the hand of the king of Syria.
They struck him, and carried away from
him a great multitude of captives, and
brought them to Damascus. He was also
delivered into the hand of the king of
Israel, who struck him with a great
slaughter.
6 For Pekah the son of Remaliah killed in
Judah one hundred twenty thousand in
one day, all of them valiant men, because
they had forsaken Yahweh, the God of
their fathers.
7 Zichri, a mighty man of Ephraim,
killed Maaseiah the king's son, Azrikam
the ruler of the house, and Elkanah who
was next to the king.
8 The children of Israel carried away
captive of their brothers two hundred
thousand women, sons, and daughters,
and also took away much plunder from
them, and brought the plunder to
Samaria.
9 But a prophet of Yahweh was there,
whose name was Oded; and he went out
to meet the army that came to Samaria,
and said to them, "Behold, because
Yahweh, the God of your fathers, was
angry with Judah, he has delivered them
into your hand, and you have slain them
in a rage which has reached up to heaven.
10 Now you intend to degrade the
children of Judah and Jerusalem as male
and female slaves for yourselves. Aren't
there even with you trespasses of your
own against Yahweh your God?
11 Now hear me therefore, and send
back the captives that you have taken
captive from your brothers, for the fierce
wrath of Yahweh is on you."
12 Then some of the heads of the
children of Ephraim, Azariah the son of
Johanan, Berechiah the son of
Meshillemoth, Jehizkiah the son of
Shallum, and Amasa the son of Hadlai,
stood up against those who came from the
war,
13 and said to them, "You must not bring
in the captives here, for you intend that
which will bring on us a trespass against
Yahweh, to add to our sins and to our
guilt; for our guilt is great, and there is
fierce wrath against Israel."

14 So the armed men left the captives
and the plunder before the princes and all
the assembly.
15 The men who have been mentioned
by name rose up and took the captives,
and with the plunder clothed all who
were naked among them, dressed them,
gave them sandals, gave them something
to eat and to drink, anointed them,
carried all the feeble of them on donkeys,
and brought them to Jericho, the city of
palm trees, to their brothers. Then they
returned to Samaria.
16 At that time King Ahaz sent to the
kings of Assyria to help him.
17 For again the Edomites had come and
struck Judah, and carried away captives.
18 The Philistines also had invaded the
cities of the lowland and of the South of
Judah, and had taken Beth Shemesh,
Aijalon, Gederoth, Soco with its villages,
Timnah with its villages, and also Gimzo
and its villages; and they lived there.
19 For Yahweh brought Judah low
because of Ahaz king of Israel, because he
acted without restraint in Judah and
trespassed severely against Yahweh.
20 Tilgath-pilneser king of Assyria came
to him and gave him trouble, but didn't
strengthen him.
21 For Ahaz took away a portion out of
Yahweh's house, and out of the house of

the king and of the princes, and gave it to the king of Assyria; but it didn't help him.
22 In the time of his distress, he trespassed yet more against Yahweh, this same King Ahaz.
23 For he sacrificed to the gods of Damascus which had defeated him. He said, "Because the gods of the kings of Syria helped them, I will sacrifice to them, that they may help me." But they were the ruin of him and of all Israel.
24 Ahaz gathered together the vessels of God's house, cut the vessels of God's house in pieces, and shut up the doors of Yahweh's house; and he made himself altars in every corner of Jerusalem.
25 In every city of Judah he made high places to burn incense to other gods, and provoked Yahweh, the God of his fathers, to anger.
26 Now the rest of his acts, and all his ways, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel.
27 Ahaz slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the city, even in Jerusalem, because they didn't bring him into the tombs of the kings of Israel; and Hezekiah his son reigned in his place.

29

1 Hezekiah began to reign when he was twenty-five years old, and he reigned twenty-nine years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Abijah, the daughter of Zechariah.
2 He did that which was right in Yahweh's eyes, according to all that David his father had done.
3 In the first year of his reign, in the first month, he opened the doors of Yahweh's house and repaired them.
4 He brought in the priests and the Levites and gathered them together into the wide place on the east,
5 and said to them, "Listen to me, you Levites! Now sanctify yourselves, and sanctify the house of Yahweh, the God of your fathers, and carry the filthiness out of the holy place.
6 For our fathers were unfaithful, and have done that which was evil in Yahweh our God's sight, and have forsaken him, and have turned away their faces from the habitation of Yahweh, and turned their backs.
7 Also they have shut up the doors of the porch, and put out the lamps, and have not burned incense nor offered burnt offerings in the holy place to the God of Israel.
8 Therefore Yahweh's wrath was on Judah and Jerusalem, and he has delivered them to be tossed back and forth, to be an astonishment and a hissing, as you see with your eyes.
9 For behold, our fathers have fallen by the sword, and our sons and our daughters and our wives are in captivity for this.
10 Now it is in my heart to make a covenant with Yahweh, the God of Israel, that his fierce anger may turn away from us.
11 My sons, don't be negligent now; for Yahweh has chosen you to stand before him, to minister to him, and that you should be his ministers and burn incense."
12 Then the Levites arose: Mahath, the son of Amasai, and Joel the son of Azariah, of the sons of the Kohathites; and of the sons of Merari, Kish the son of Abdi, and Azariah the son of Jehallelel; and of the Gershonites, Joah the son of Zimmah, and Eden the son of Joah;
13 and of the sons of Elizaphan, Shimri and Jeuel; and of the sons of Asaph, Zechariah and Mattaniah;
14 and of the sons of Heman, Jehuel and Shimei; and of the sons of Jeduthun, Shemaiah and Uzziel.
15 They gathered their brothers, sanctified themselves, and went in, according to the commandment of the king by Yahweh's words, to cleanse Yahweh's house.
16 The priests went into the inner part of Yahweh's house to cleanse it, and brought out all the uncleanness that they found in Yahweh's temple into the court of Yahweh's house. The Levites took it from there to carry it out to the brook Kidron.
17 Now they began on the first day of the first month to sanctify, and on the eighth

day of the month they came to Yahweh's porch. They sanctified Yahweh's house in eight days, and on the sixteenth day of the first month they finished.
18 Then they went in to Hezekiah the king within the palace and said, "We have cleansed all Yahweh's house, including the altar of burnt offering with all its vessels, and the table of show bread with all its vessels.
19 Moreover, we have prepared and sanctified all the vessels which King Ahaz threw away in his reign when he was unfaithful. Behold, they are before Yahweh's altar."
20 Then Hezekiah the king arose early, gathered the princes of the city, and went up to Yahweh's house.
21 They brought seven bulls, seven rams, seven lambs, and seven male goats, for a sin offering for the kingdom, for the sanctuary, and for Judah. He commanded the priests the sons of Aaron to offer them on Yahweh's altar.
22 So they killed the bulls, and the priests received the blood and sprinkled it on the altar. They killed the rams and sprinkled the blood on the altar. They also killed the lambs and sprinkled the blood on the altar.
23 They brought near the male goats for the sin offering before the king and the assembly; and they laid their hands on them.
24 Then the priests killed them, and they made a sin offering with their blood on the altar, to make atonement for all Israel; for the king commanded that the burnt offering and the sin offering should be made for all Israel.
25 He set the Levites in Yahweh's house with cymbals, with stringed instruments, and with harps, according to the commandment of David, of Gad the king's seer, and Nathan the prophet; for the commandment was from Yahweh by his prophets.
26 The Levites stood with David's instruments, and the priests with the trumpets.
27 Hezekiah commanded them to offer the burnt offering on the altar. When the burnt offering began, Yahweh's song also began, along with the trumpets and instruments of David king of Israel.
28 All the assembly worshiped, the singers sang, and the trumpeters sounded. All this continued until the burnt offering was finished.
29 When they had finished offering, the king and all who were present with him bowed themselves and worshiped.
30 Moreover Hezekiah the king and the princes commanded the Levites to sing praises to Yahweh with the words of David, and of Asaph the seer. They sang praises with gladness, and they bowed their heads and worshiped.
31 Then Hezekiah answered, "Now you have consecrated yourselves to Yahweh. Come near and bring sacrifices and thank offerings into Yahweh's house." The assembly brought in sacrifices and thank offerings, and as many as were of a willing heart brought burnt offerings.
32 The number of the burnt offerings which the assembly brought was seventy bulls, one hundred rams, and two hundred lambs. All these were for a burnt offering to Yahweh.
33 The consecrated things were six hundred head of cattle and three thousand sheep.
34 But the priests were too few, so that they could not skin all the burnt offerings. Therefore their brothers the Levites helped them until the work was ended, and until the priests had sanctified themselves, for the Levites were more upright in heart to sanctify themselves than the priests.
35 Also the burnt offerings were in abundance, with the fat of the peace offerings and with the drink offerings for every burnt offering. So the service of Yahweh's house was set in order.
36 Hezekiah and all the people rejoiced because of that which God had prepared for the people; for the thing was done suddenly.

30

1 Hezekiah sent to all Israel and Judah,

and wrote letters also to Ephraim and Manasseh, that they should come to Yahweh's house at Jerusalem, to keep the Passover to Yahweh, the God of Israel.
2 For the king had taken counsel with his princes and all the assembly in Jerusalem to keep the Passover in the second month.
3 For they could not keep it at that time, because the priests had not sanctified themselves in sufficient number, and the people had not gathered themselves together to Jerusalem.
4 The thing was right in the eyes of the king and of all the assembly.
5 So they established a decree to make proclamation throughout all Israel, from Beersheba even to Dan, that they should come to keep the Passover to Yahweh, the God of Israel, at Jerusalem, for they had not kept it in great numbers in the way it is written.
6 So the couriers went with the letters from the king and his princes throughout all Israel and Judah, according to the commandment of the king, saying, "You children of Israel, turn again to Yahweh, the God of Abraham, Isaac, and Israel, that he may return to the remnant of you that have escaped out of the hand of the kings of Assyria.
7 Don't be like your fathers and like your brothers, who trespassed against Yahweh, the God of their fathers, so that he gave them up to desolation, as you see.
8 Now don't be stiff-necked, as your fathers were, but yield yourselves to Yahweh, and enter into his sanctuary, which he has sanctified forever, and serve Yahweh your God, that his fierce anger may turn away from you.
9 For if you turn again to Yahweh, your brothers and your children will find compassion with those who led them captive, and will come again into this land, because Yahweh your God is gracious and merciful, and will not turn away his face from you if you return to him."
10 So the couriers passed from city to city through the country of Ephraim and Manasseh, even to Zebulun, but people ridiculed them and mocked them.
11 Nevertheless some men of Asher, Manasseh, and Zebulun humbled themselves and came to Jerusalem.
12 Also the hand of God came on Judah to give them one heart, to do the commandment of the king and of the princes by Yahweh's word.
13 Many people assembled at Jerusalem to keep the feast of unleavened bread in the second month, a very great assembly.
14 They arose and took away the altars that were in Jerusalem, and they took away all the altars for incense and threw them into the brook Kidron.
15 Then they killed the Passover on the fourteenth day of the second month. The priests and the Levites were ashamed, and sanctified themselves, and brought burnt offerings into Yahweh's house.
16 They stood in their place after their order, according to the law of Moses the man of God. The priests sprinkled the blood which they received of the hand of the Levites.
17 For there were many in the assembly who had not sanctified themselves; therefore the Levites were in charge of killing the Passovers for everyone who was not clean, to sanctify them to Yahweh.
18 For a multitude of the people, even many of Ephraim, Manasseh, Issachar, and Zebulun, had not cleansed themselves, yet they ate the Passover other than the way it is written. For Hezekiah had prayed for them, saying, "May the good Yahweh pardon everyone
19 who sets his heart to seek God, Yahweh, the God of his fathers, even if they aren't clean according to the purification of the sanctuary."
20 Yahweh listened to Hezekiah, and healed the people.
21 The children of Israel who were present at Jerusalem kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with great gladness. The Levites and the priests praised Yahweh day by day, singing with loud instruments to Yahweh.
22 Hezekiah spoke encouragingly to all the Levites who had good understanding

in the service of Yahweh. So they ate throughout the feast for the seven days, offering sacrifices of peace offerings and making confession to Yahweh, the God of their fathers.
23 The whole assembly took counsel to keep another seven days, and they kept another seven days with gladness.
24 For Hezekiah king of Judah gave to the assembly for offerings one thousand bulls and seven thousand sheep; and the princes gave to the assembly a thousand bulls and ten thousand sheep; and a great number of priests sanctified themselves.
25 All the assembly of Judah, with the priests and the Levites, and all the assembly who came out of Israel, and the foreigners who came out of the land of Israel and who lived in Judah, rejoiced.
26 So there was great joy in Jerusalem; for since the time of Solomon the son of David king of Israel there was nothing like this in Jerusalem.
27 Then the Levitical priests arose and blessed the people. Their voice was heard, and their prayer came up to his holy habitation, even to heaven.

31

1 Now when all this was finished, all Israel who were present went out to the cities of Judah and broke the pillars in pieces, cut down the Asherah poles, and broke down the high places and the altars out of all Judah and Benjamin, also in Ephraim and Manasseh, until they had destroyed them all. Then all the children of Israel returned, every man to his possession, into their own cities.

2 Hezekiah appointed the divisions of the priests and the Levites after their divisions, every man according to his service, both the priests and the Levites, for burnt offerings and for peace offerings, to minister, to give thanks, and to praise in the gates of Yahweh's camp.
3 He also appointed the king's portion of his possessions for the burnt offerings: for the morning and evening burnt offerings, and the burnt offerings for the Sabbaths, for the new moons, and for the set feasts, as it is written in Yahweh's law.
4 Moreover he commanded the people who lived in Jerusalem to give the portion of the priests and the Levites, that they might give themselves to Yahweh's law.
5 As soon as the commandment went out, the children of Israel gave in abundance the first fruits of grain, new wine, oil, honey, and of all the increase of the field; and they brought in the tithe of all things abundantly.
6 The children of Israel and Judah, who lived in the cities of Judah, also brought in the tithe of cattle and sheep, and the tithe of dedicated things which were consecrated to Yahweh their God, and laid them in heaps.
7 In the third month, they began to lay the foundation of the heaps, and finished them in the seventh month.
8 When Hezekiah and the princes came and saw the heaps, they blessed Yahweh and his people Israel.
9 Then Hezekiah questioned the priests and the Levites about the heaps.
10 Azariah the chief priest, of the house of Zadok, answered him and said, "Since people began to bring the offerings into Yahweh's house, we have eaten and had enough, and have plenty left over, for Yahweh has blessed his people; and that which is left is this great store."
11 Then Hezekiah commanded them to prepare rooms in Yahweh's house, and they prepared them.
12 They brought in the offerings, the tithes, and the dedicated things faithfully. Conaniah the Levite was ruler over them, and Shimei his brother was second.
13 Jehiel, Azaziah, Nahath, Asahel, Jerimoth, Jozabad, Eliel, Ismachiah, Mahath, and Benaiah were overseers under the hand of Conaniah and Shimei his brother, by the appointment of Hezekiah the king and Azariah the ruler of God's house.
14 Kore the son of Imnah the Levite, the gatekeeper at the east gate, was over the free will offerings of God, to distribute Yahweh's offerings and the most holy things.

15 Under him were Eden, Miniamin, Jeshua, Shemaiah, Amariah, and Shecaniah, in the cities of the priests, in their office of trust, to give to their brothers by divisions, to the great as well as to the small;
16 in addition to those who were listed by genealogy of males, from three years old and upward, even everyone who entered into Yahweh's house, as the duty of every day required, for their service in their offices according to their divisions;
17 and those who were listed by genealogy of the priests by their fathers' houses, and the Levites from twenty years old and upward, in their offices by their divisions;
18 and those who were listed by genealogy of all their little ones, their wives, their sons, and their daughters, through all the congregation; for in their office of trust they sanctified themselves in holiness.
19 Also for the sons of Aaron the priests, who were in the fields of the pasture lands of their cities, in every city, there were men who were mentioned by name to give portions to all the males among the priests and to all who were listed by genealogy among the Levites.
20 Hezekiah did so throughout all Judah; and he did that which was good, right, and faithful before Yahweh his God.
21 In every work that he began in the service of God's house, in the law, and in the commandments, to seek his God, he did it with all his heart and prospered.

32

1 After these things and this faithfulness, Sennacherib king of Assyria came, entered into Judah, encamped against the fortified cities, and intended to win them for himself.
2 When Hezekiah saw that Sennacherib had come, and that he was planning to fight against Jerusalem,
3 he took counsel with his princes and his mighty men to stop the waters of the springs which were outside of the city, and they helped him.
4 Then many people gathered together and they stopped all the springs and the brook that flowed through the middle of the land, saying, "Why should the kings of Assyria come, and find abundant water?"
5 He took courage, built up all the wall that was broken down, and raised it up to the towers, with the other wall outside, and strengthened Millo in David's city, and made weapons and shields in abundance.
6 He set captains of war over the people, gathered them together to him in the wide place at the gate of the city, and spoke encouragingly to them, saying,
7 "Be strong and courageous. Don't be afraid or dismayed because of the king of Assyria, nor for all the multitude who is with him; for there is a greater one with us than with him.
8 An arm of flesh is with him, but Yahweh our God is with us to help us and to fight our battles." The people rested themselves on the words of Hezekiah king of Judah.
9 After this, Sennacherib king of Assyria sent his servants to Jerusalem, (now he was attacking Lachish, and all his forces were with him), to Hezekiah king of Judah, and to all Judah who were at Jerusalem, saying,
10 Sennacherib king of Assyria says, "In whom do you trust, that you remain under siege in Jerusalem?
11 Doesn't Hezekiah persuade you to give you over to die by famine and by thirst, saying, 'Yahweh our God will deliver us out of the hand of the king of Assyria'?
12 Hasn't the same Hezekiah taken away his high places and his altars, and commanded Judah and Jerusalem, saying, 'You shall worship before one altar, and you shall burn incense on it'?
13 Don't you know what I and my fathers have done to all the peoples of the lands? Were the gods of the nations of those lands in any way able to deliver their land out of my hand?
14 Who was there among all the gods of those nations which my fathers utterly

destroyed that could deliver his people out of my hand, that your God should be able to deliver you out of my hand?
15 Now therefore don't let Hezekiah deceive you nor persuade you in this way. Don't believe him, for no god of any nation or kingdom was able to deliver his people out of my hand, and out of the hand of my fathers. How much less will your God deliver you out of my hand?"

16 His servants spoke yet more against Yahweh God and against his servant Hezekiah.
17 He also wrote letters insulting Yahweh, the God of Israel, and speaking against him, saying, "As the gods of the nations of the lands, which have not delivered their people out of my hand, so shall the God of Hezekiah not deliver his people out of my hand."
18 They called out with a loud voice in the Jews' language to the people of Jerusalem who were on the wall, to frighten them and to trouble them, that they might take the city.
19 They spoke of the God of Jerusalem as of the gods of the peoples of the earth, which are the work of men's hands.

20 Hezekiah the king and Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, prayed because of this, and cried to heaven.

21 Yahweh sent an angel, who cut off all the mighty men of valor, the leaders, and captains in the camp of the king of Assyria. So he returned with shame of face to his own land. When he had come into the house of his god, those who came out of his own body† killed him there with the sword.
22 Thus Yahweh saved Hezekiah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem from the hand of Sennacherib the king of Assyria and from the hand of all others, and guided them on every side.
23 Many brought gifts to Yahweh to Jerusalem, and precious things to Hezekiah king of Judah, so that he was exalted in the sight of all nations from then on.

24 In those days Hezekiah was terminally ill, and he prayed to Yahweh; and he spoke to him, and gave him a sign.
25 But Hezekiah didn't reciprocate appropriate to the benefit done for him, because his heart was lifted up. Therefore there was wrath on him, Judah, and Jerusalem.
26 However, Hezekiah humbled himself for the pride of his heart, both he and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, so that Yahweh's wrath didn't come on them in the days of Hezekiah.
27 Hezekiah had exceedingly great riches and honor. He provided himself with treasuries for silver, for gold, for precious stones, for spices, for shields, and for all kinds of valuable vessels;
28 also storehouses for the increase of grain, new wine, and oil; and stalls for all kinds of animals, and flocks in folds.
29 Moreover he provided for himself cities, and possessions of flocks and herds in abundance; for God had given him abundant possessions.
30 This same Hezekiah also stopped the upper spring of the waters of Gihon, and brought them straight down on the west side of David's city. Hezekiah prospered in all his works.
31 However, concerning the ambassadors of the princes of Babylon, who sent to him to inquire of the wonder that was done in the land, God left him to test him, that he might know all that was in his heart.
32 Now the rest of the acts of Hezekiah and his good deeds, behold, they are written in the vision of Isaiah the prophet, the son of Amoz, in the book of the kings of Judah and Israel.
33 Hezekiah slept with his fathers, and they buried him in the ascent to the tombs of the sons of David. All Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem honored him at his death. Manasseh his son reigned in his place.

33

1 Manasseh was twelve years old when

† **32:21** i.e., his own sons

he began to reign, and he reigned
fifty-five years in Jerusalem.
2 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's
sight, after the abominations of the
nations whom Yahweh cast out before the
children of Israel.
3 For he built again the high places
which Hezekiah his father had broken
down; and he raised up altars for the
Baals, made Asheroth, and worshiped all
the army of the sky, and served them.
4 He built altars in Yahweh's house, of
which Yahweh said, "My name shall be in
Jerusalem forever."
5 He built altars for all the army of the
sky in the two courts of Yahweh's house.
6 He also made his children to pass
through the fire in the valley of the son of
Hinnom. He practiced sorcery, divination,
and witchcraft, and dealt with those who
had familiar spirits and with wizards. He
did much evil in Yahweh's sight, to
provoke him to anger.
7 He set the engraved image of the idol,
which he had made, in God's house, of
which God said to David and to Solomon
his son, "In this house, and in Jerusalem,
which I have chosen out of all the tribes of
Israel, I will put my name forever.
8 I will not any more remove the foot of
Israel from off the land which I have
appointed for your fathers, if only they
will observe to do all that I have
commanded them, even all the law, the
statutes, and the ordinances given by
Moses."
9 Manasseh seduced Judah and the
inhabitants of Jerusalem, so that they did
more evil than did the nations whom
Yahweh destroyed before the children of
Israel.
10 Yahweh spoke to Manasseh and to his
people, but they didn't listen.
11 Therefore Yahweh brought on them
the captains of the army of the king of
Assyria, who took Manasseh in chains,
bound him with fetters, and carried him
to Babylon.
12 When he was in distress, he begged
Yahweh his God, and humbled himself
greatly before the God of his fathers.
13 He prayed to him; and he was
entreated by him, and heard his
supplication, and brought him again to
Jerusalem into his kingdom. Then
Manasseh knew that Yahweh was God.
14 Now after this, he built an outer wall
to David's city on the west side of Gihon,
in the valley, even to the entrance at the
fish gate. He encircled Ophel with it, and
raised it up to a very great height; and he
put valiant captains in all the fortified
cities of Judah.
15 He took away the foreign gods and
the idol out of Yahweh's house, and all the
altars that he had built in the mountain of
Yahweh's house and in Jerusalem, and
cast them out of the city.
16 He built up Yahweh's altar, and
offered sacrifices of peace offerings and
of thanksgiving on it, and commanded
Judah to serve Yahweh, the God of Israel.
17 Nevertheless the people still
sacrificed in the high places, but only to
Yahweh their God.
18 Now the rest of the acts of Manasseh,
and his prayer to his God, and the words
of the seers who spoke to him in the name
of Yahweh, the God of Israel, behold, they
are written among the acts of the kings of
Israel.
19 His prayer also, and how God listened
to his request, and all his sin and his
trespass, and the places in which he built
high places and set up the Asherah poles
and the engraved images before he
humbled himself: behold, they are
written in the history of Hozai.†
20 So Manasseh slept with his fathers,
and they buried him in his own house;
and Amon his son reigned in his place.
21 Amon was twenty-two years old
when he began to reign; and he reigned
two years in Jerusalem.
22 He did that which was evil in
Yahweh's sight, as did Manasseh his
father; and Amon sacrificed to all the
engraved images which Manasseh his
father had made, and served them.
23 He didn't humble himself before
Yahweh, as Manasseh his father had

† **33:19** or, the seers

humbled himself; but this same Amon
trespassed more and more.
24 His servants conspired against him,
and put him to death in his own house.
25 But the people of the land killed all
those who had conspired against King
Amon; and the people of the land made
Josiah his son king in his place.

34

1 Josiah was eight years old when he
began to reign, and he reigned thirty-one
years in Jerusalem.
2 He did that which was right in
Yahweh's eyes, and walked in the ways of
David his father, and didn't turn away to
the right hand or to the left.
3 For in the eighth year of his reign,
while he was yet young, he began to seek
after the God of David his father; and in
the twelfth year he began to purge Judah
and Jerusalem from the high places, the
Asherah poles, the engraved images, and
the molten images.
4 They broke down the altars of the
Baals in his presence; and he cut down the
incense altars that were on high above
them. He broke the Asherah poles, the
engraved images, and the molten images
in pieces, made dust of them, and
scattered it on the graves of those who
had sacrificed to them.
5 He burned the bones of the priests on
their altars, and purged Judah and
Jerusalem.
6 He did this in the cities of Manasseh,
Ephraim, and Simeon, even to Naphtali,
around in their ruins.
7 He broke down the altars, beat the
Asherah poles and the engraved images
into powder, and cut down all the incense
altars throughout all the land of Israel,
then returned to Jerusalem.

8 Now in the eighteenth year of his
reign, when he had purged the land and
the house, he sent Shaphan the son of
Azaliah, Maaseiah the governor of the
city, and Joah the son of Joahaz the
recorder to repair the house of Yahweh
his God.

9 They came to Hilkiah the high priest
and delivered the money that was
brought into God's house, which the
Levites, the keepers of the threshold, had
gathered from the hands of Manasseh,
Ephraim, of all the remnant of Israel, of
all Judah and Benjamin, and of the
inhabitants of Jerusalem.
10 They delivered it into the hands of the
workmen who had the oversight of
Yahweh's house; and the workmen who
labored in Yahweh's house gave it to
mend and repair the house.
11 They gave it to the carpenters and to
the builders to buy cut stone and timber
for couplings, and to make beams for the
houses which the kings of Judah had
destroyed.
12 The men did the work faithfully.
Their overseers were Jahath and Obadiah
the Levites, of the sons of Merari; and
Zechariah and Meshullam, of the sons of
the Kohathites, to give direction; and
others of the Levites, who were all skillful
with musical instruments.
13 Also they were over the bearers of
burdens, and directed all who did the
work in every kind of service. Of the
Levites, there were scribes, officials, and
gatekeepers.

14 When they brought out the money
that was brought into Yahweh's house,
Hilkiah the priest found the book of
Yahweh's law given by Moses.
15 Hilkiah answered Shaphan the
scribe, "I have found the book of the law
in Yahweh's house." So Hilkiah delivered
the book to Shaphan.

16 Shaphan carried the book to the king,
and moreover brought back word to the
king, saying, "All that was committed to
your servants, they are doing.
17 They have emptied out the money
that was found in Yahweh's house, and
have delivered it into the hand of the
overseers and into the hand of the
workmen."
18 Shaphan the scribe told the king,
saying, "Hilkiah the priest has delivered
me a book." Shaphan read from it to the
king.

19 When the king had heard the words
of the law, he tore his clothes.
20 The king commanded Hilkiah,
Ahikam the son of Shaphan, Abdon the
son of Micah, Shaphan the scribe, and
Asaiah the king's servant, saying,
21 "Go inquire of Yahweh for me, and for
those who are left in Israel and in Judah,
concerning the words of the book that is
found; for great is Yahweh's wrath that is
poured out on us, because our fathers
have not kept Yahweh's word, to do
according to all that is written in this
book."
22 So Hilkiah and those whom the king
had commanded went to Huldah the
prophetess, the wife of Shallum the son of
Tokhath, the son of Hasrah, keeper of the
wardrobe (now she lived in Jerusalem in
the second quarter), and they spoke to her
to that effect.
23 She said to them, "Yahweh, the God of
Israel says: 'Tell the man who sent you to
me,
24 "Yahweh says, 'Behold, I will bring
evil on this place and on its inhabitants,
even all the curses that are written in the
book which they have read before the
king of Judah.
25 Because they have forsaken me, and
have burned incense to other gods, that
they might provoke me to anger with all
the works of their hands, therefore my
wrath is poured out on this place, and it
will not be quenched.' " '
26 But to the king of Judah, who sent you
to inquire of Yahweh, you shall tell him
this, 'Yahweh, the God of Israel says:
"About the words which you have heard,
27 because your heart was tender, and
you humbled yourself before God when
you heard his words against this place
and against its inhabitants, and have
humbled yourself before me, and have
torn your clothes and wept before me, I
also have heard you," says Yahweh.
28 "Behold, I will gather you to your
fathers, and you will be gathered to your
grave in peace. Your eyes won't see all the
evil that I will bring on this place and on
its inhabitants." ' "

They brought back this message to the
king.
29 Then the king sent and gathered
together all the elders of Judah and
Jerusalem.
30 The king went up to Yahweh's house
with all the men of Judah and the
inhabitants of Jerusalem—the priests, the
Levites, and all the people, both great and
small—and he read in their hearing all the
words of the book of the covenant that
was found in Yahweh's house.
31 The king stood in his place and made
a covenant before Yahweh, to walk after
Yahweh, and to keep his commandments,
his testimonies, and his statutes with all
his heart and with all his soul, to perform
the words of the covenant that were
written in this book.
32 He caused all who were found in
Jerusalem and Benjamin to stand. The
inhabitants of Jerusalem did according to
the covenant of God, the God of their
fathers.
33 Josiah took away all the abominations
out of all the countries that belonged to
the children of Israel, and made all who
were found in Israel to serve, even to
serve Yahweh their God. All his days they
didn't depart from following Yahweh, the
God of their fathers.

35

1 Josiah kept a Passover to Yahweh in
Jerusalem. They killed the Passover on
the fourteenth day of the first month.
2 He set the priests in their offices and
encouraged them in the service of
Yahweh's house.
3 He said to the Levites who taught all
Israel, who were holy to Yahweh, "Put the
holy ark in the house which Solomon the
son of David king of Israel built. It will no
longer be a burden on your shoulders.
Now serve Yahweh your God and his
people Israel.
4 Prepare yourselves after your fathers'
houses by your divisions, according to the
writing of David king of Israel, and
according to the writing of Solomon his
son.
5 Stand in the holy place according to
the divisions of the fathers' houses of your

brothers the children of the people, and let there be for each a portion of a fathers' house of the Levites.
6 Kill the Passover lamb, sanctify yourselves, and prepare for your brothers, to do according to Yahweh's word by Moses."

7 Josiah gave to the children of the people, of the flock, lambs and young goats, all of them for the Passover offerings, to all who were present, to the number of thirty thousand, and three thousand bulls. These were of the king's substance.
8 His princes gave a free will offering to the people, to the priests, and to the Levites. Hilkiah, Zechariah, and Jehiel, the rulers of God's house, gave to the priests for the Passover offerings two thousand six hundred small livestock, and three hundred head of cattle.
9 Conaniah also, and Shemaiah and Nethanel, his brothers, and Hashabiah, Jeiel, and Jozabad, the chiefs of the Levites, gave to the Levites for the Passover offerings five thousand small livestock and five hundred head of cattle.

10 So the service was prepared, and the priests stood in their place, and the Levites by their divisions, according to the king's commandment.
11 They killed the Passover lambs, and the priests sprinkled the blood which they received from their hands, and the Levites skinned them.
12 They removed the burnt offerings, that they might give them according to the divisions of the fathers' houses of the children of the people, to offer to Yahweh, as it is written in the book of Moses. They did the same with the cattle.
13 They roasted the Passover with fire according to the ordinance. They boiled the holy offerings in pots, in cauldrons, and in pans, and carried them quickly to all the children of the people.
14 Afterward they prepared for themselves and for the priests, because the priests the sons of Aaron were busy with offering the burnt offerings and the fat until night. Therefore the Levites prepared for themselves and for the priests the sons of Aaron.
15 The singers, the sons of Asaph, were in their place, according to the commandment of David, Asaph, Heman, and Jeduthun the king's seer; and the gatekeepers were at every gate. They didn't need to depart from their service, because their brothers the Levites prepared for them.
16 So all the service of Yahweh was prepared the same day, to keep the Passover, and to offer burnt offerings on Yahweh's altar, according to the commandment of King Josiah.
17 The children of Israel who were present kept the Passover at that time, and the feast of unleavened bread seven days.
18 There was no Passover like that kept in Israel from the days of Samuel the prophet, nor did any of the kings of Israel keep such a Passover as Josiah kept—with the priests, the Levites, and all Judah and Israel who were present, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem.
19 This Passover was kept in the eighteenth year of the reign of Josiah.

20 After all this, when Josiah had prepared the temple, Neco king of Egypt went up to fight against Carchemish by the Euphrates, and Josiah went out against him.
21 But he sent ambassadors to him, saying, "What have I to do with you, you king of Judah? I come not against you today, but against the house with which I have war. God has commanded me to make haste. Beware that it is God who is with me, that he not destroy you."
22 Nevertheless Josiah would not turn his face from him, but disguised himself, that he might fight with him, and didn't listen to the words of Neco from the mouth of God, and came to fight in the valley of Megiddo.
23 The archers shot at King Josiah; and the king said to his servants, "Take me away, because I am seriously wounded!"
24 So his servants took him out of the chariot, and put him in the second chariot that he had, and brought him to

Jerusalem; and he died, and was buried in the tombs of his fathers. All Judah and Jerusalem mourned for Josiah.
25 Jeremiah lamented for Josiah, and all the singing men and singing women spoke of Josiah in their lamentations to this day; and they made them an ordinance in Israel. Behold, they are written in the lamentations.
26 Now the rest of the acts of Josiah and his good deeds, according to that which is written in Yahweh's law,
27 and his acts, first and last, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah.

36

1 Then the people of the land took Jehoahaz the son of Josiah, and made him king in his father's place in Jerusalem.
2 Joahaz was twenty-three years old when he began to reign; and he reigned three months in Jerusalem.
3 The king of Egypt removed him from office at Jerusalem, and fined the land one hundred talents of silver and a talent† of gold.
4 The king of Egypt made Eliakim his brother king over Judah and Jerusalem, and changed his name to Jehoiakim. Neco took Joahaz his brother, and carried him to Egypt.
5 Jehoiakim was twenty-five years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. He did that which was evil in Yahweh his God's sight.
6 Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up against him, and bound him in fetters to carry him to Babylon.
7 Nebuchadnezzar also carried some of the vessels of Yahweh's house to Babylon, and put them in his temple at Babylon.
8 Now the rest of the acts of Jehoiakim, and his abominations which he did, and that which was found in him, behold, they are written in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah; and Jehoiachin his son reigned in his place.
9 Jehoiachin was eight years old when he began to reign, and he reigned three months and ten days in Jerusalem. He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight.
10 At the return of the year, King Nebuchadnezzar sent and brought him to Babylon, with the valuable vessels of Yahweh's house, and made Zedekiah his brother king over Judah and Jerusalem.
11 Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he began to reign, and he reigned eleven years in Jerusalem.
12 He did that which was evil in Yahweh his God's sight. He didn't humble himself before Jeremiah the prophet speaking from Yahweh's mouth.
13 He also rebelled against King Nebuchadnezzar, who had made him swear by God; but he stiffened his neck, and hardened his heart against turning to Yahweh, the God of Israel.
14 Moreover all the chiefs of the priests and the people trespassed very greatly after all the abominations of the nations; and they polluted Yahweh's house which he had made holy in Jerusalem.
15 Yahweh, the God of their fathers, sent to them by his messengers, rising up early and sending, because he had compassion on his people and on his dwelling place;
16 but they mocked the messengers of God, despised his words, and scoffed at his prophets, until Yahweh's wrath arose against his people, until there was no remedy.
17 Therefore he brought on them the king of the Chaldeans, who killed their young men with the sword in the house of their sanctuary, and had no compassion on young man or virgin, old man or infirm. He gave them all into his hand.
18 All the vessels of God's house, great and small, and the treasures of Yahweh's house, and the treasures of the king and of his princes, all these he brought to Babylon.
19 They burned God's house, broke down the wall of Jerusalem, burned all its

36:2 *Joahaz* is a variant of *Jehoahaz*. † **36:3** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces **36:4** *Joahaz* is a variant of *Jehoahaz*.

palaces with fire, and destroyed all of its valuable vessels.
20 He carried those who had escaped from the sword away to Babylon, and they were servants to him and his sons until the reign of the kingdom of Persia,
21 to fulfill Yahweh's word by Jeremiah's mouth, until the land had enjoyed its Sabbaths. As long as it lay desolate, it kept Sabbath, to fulfill seventy years.
22 Now in the first year of Cyrus king of Persia, that Yahweh's word by the mouth of Jeremiah might be accomplished, Yahweh stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of Persia, so that he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and put it also in writing, saying,
23 "Cyrus king of Persia says, 'Yahweh, the God of heaven, has given all the kingdoms of the earth to me; and he has commanded me to build him a house in Jerusalem, which is in Judah. Whoever there is among you of all his people, Yahweh his God be with him, and let him go up.' "

The Book of Ezra

1 Now in the first year of Cyrus king of
Persia, that Yahweh's† word by Jeremiah's
mouth might be accomplished, Yahweh
stirred up the spirit of Cyrus king of
Persia, so that he made a proclamation
throughout all his kingdom, and put it
also in writing, saying,
2 "Cyrus king of Persia says, 'Yahweh,
the God‡ of heaven, has given me all the
kingdoms of the earth; and he has
commanded me to build him a house in
Jerusalem, which is in Judah.
3 Whoever there is among you of all his
people, may his God be with him, and let
him go up to Jerusalem, which is in Judah,
and build the house of Yahweh, the God of
Israel (he is God), which is in Jerusalem.
4 Whoever is left, in any place where he
lives, let the men of his place help him
with silver, with gold, with goods, and
with animals, in addition to the free will
offering for God's house which is in
Jerusalem.' "

5 Then the heads of fathers' households
of Judah and Benjamin, the priests and
the Levites, all whose spirit God had
stirred to go up, rose up to build Yahweh's
house which is in Jerusalem.
6 All those who were around them
strengthened their hands with vessels of
silver, with gold, with goods, with
animals, and with precious things, in
addition to all that was willingly offered.
7 Also Cyrus the king brought out the
vessels of Yahweh's house, which
Nebuchadnezzar had brought out of
Jerusalem, and had put in the house of his
gods;
8 even those, Cyrus king of Persia
brought out by the hand of Mithredath the
treasurer, and counted them out to
Sheshbazzar the prince of Judah.
9 This is the number of them: thirty
platters of gold, one thousand platters of
silver, twenty-nine knives,
10 thirty bowls of gold, four hundred ten
silver bowls of a second kind, and one
thousand other vessels.
11 All the vessels of gold and of silver
were five thousand four hundred.
Sheshbazzar brought all these up when
the captives were brought up from
Babylon to Jerusalem.

2

1 Now these are the children of the
province who went up out of the captivity
of those who had been carried away,
whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of
Babylon had carried away to Babylon,
and who returned to Jerusalem and
Judah, everyone to his city;
2 who came with Zerubbabel, Jeshua,
Nehemiah, Seraiah, Reelaiah, Mordecai,
Bilshan, Mispar, Bigvai, Rehum, and
Baanah.
The number of the men of the people of
Israel:
3 The children of Parosh, two thousand
one hundred seventy-two.
4 The children of Shephatiah, three
hundred seventy-two.
5 The children of Arah, seven hundred
seventy-five.
6 The children of Pahathmoab, of the
children of Jeshua and Joab, two thousand
eight hundred twelve.
7 The children of Elam, one thousand
two hundred fifty-four.
8 The children of Zattu, nine hundred
forty-five.
9 The children of Zaccai, seven hundred
sixty.
10 The children of Bani, six hundred
forty-two.
11 The children of Bebai, six hundred
twenty-three.
12 The children of Azgad, one thousand
two hundred twenty-two.
13 The children of Adonikam, six
hundred sixty-six.

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:2** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

14 The children of Bigvai, two thousand
fifty-six.
15 The children of Adin, four hundred
fifty-four.
16 The children of Ater, of Hezekiah,
ninety-eight.
17 The children of Bezai, three hundred
twenty-three.
18 The children of Jorah, one hundred
twelve.
19 The children of Hashum, two
hundred twenty-three.
20 The children of Gibbar, ninety-five.
21 The children of Bethlehem, one
hundred twenty-three.
22 The men of Netophah, fifty-six.
23 The men of Anathoth, one hundred
twenty-eight.
24 The children of Azmaveth, forty-two.
25 The children of Kiriath Arim,
Chephirah, and Beeroth, seven hundred
forty-three.
26 The children of Ramah and Geba, six
hundred twenty-one.
27 The men of Michmas, one hundred
twenty-two.
28 The men of Bethel and Ai, two
hundred twenty-three.
29 The children of Nebo, fifty-two.
30 The children of Magbish, one
hundred fifty-six.
31 The children of the other Elam, one
thousand two hundred fifty-four.
32 The children of Harim, three hundred
twenty.
33 The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono,
seven hundred twenty-five.
34 The children of Jericho, three
hundred forty-five.
35 The children of Senaah, three
thousand six hundred thirty.

36 The priests: the children of Jedaiah, of
the house of Jeshua, nine hundred
seventy-three.
37 The children of Immer, one thousand
fifty-two.
38 The children of Pashhur, one
thousand two hundred forty-seven.
39 The children of Harim, one thousand
seventeen.

40 The Levites: the children of Jeshua
and Kadmiel, of the children of Hodaviah,
seventy-four.
41 The singers: the children of Asaph,
one hundred twenty-eight.
42 The children of the gatekeepers: the
children of Shallum, the children of Ater,
the children of Talmon, the children of
Akkub, the children of Hatita, the children
of Shobai, in all one hundred thirty-nine.

43 The temple servants: the children of
Ziha, the children of Hasupha, the
children of Tabbaoth,
44 the children of Keros, the children of
Siaha, the children of Padon,
45 the children of Lebanah, the children
of Hagabah, the children of Akkub,
46 the children of Hagab, the children of
Shamlai, the children of Hanan,
47 the children of Giddel, the children of
Gahar, the children of Reaiah,
48 the children of Rezin, the children of
Nekoda, the children of Gazzam,
49 the children of Uzza, the children of
Paseah, the children of Besai,
50 the children of Asnah, the children of
Meunim, the children of Nephisim,
51 the children of Bakbuk, the children
of Hakupha, the children of Harhur,
52 the children of Bazluth, the children
of Mehida, the children of Harsha,
53 the children of Barkos, the children of
Sisera, the children of Temah,
54 the children of Neziah, the children of
Hatipha.

55 The children of Solomon's servants:
the children of Sotai, the children of
Hassophereth, the children of Peruda,
56 the children of Jaalah, the children of
Darkon, the children of Giddel,
57 the children of Shephatiah, the
children of Hattil, the children of
Pochereth Hazzebaim, the children of
Ami.
58 All the temple servants, and the
children of Solomon's servants, were
three hundred ninety-two.

59 These were those who went up from
Tel Melah, Tel Harsha, Cherub, Addan,
and Immer; but they could not show their

† **2:59** or, seed

fathers' houses and their offspring,† whether they were of Israel:
60 the children of Delaiah, the children of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda, six hundred fifty-two.
61 Of the children of the priests: the children of Habaiah, the children of Hakkoz, and the children of Barzillai, who took a wife of the daughters of Barzillai the Gileadite, and was called after their name.
62 These sought their place among those who were registered by genealogy, but they were not found; therefore they were deemed disqualified and removed from the priesthood.
63 The governor told them that they should not eat of the most holy things until a priest stood up to serve with Urim and with Thummim.
64 The whole assembly together was forty-two thousand three hundred sixty,
65 in addition to their male servants and their female servants, of whom there were seven thousand three hundred thirty-seven; and they had two hundred singing men and singing women.
66 Their horses were seven hundred thirty-six; their mules, two hundred forty-five;
67 their camels, four hundred thirty-five; their donkeys, six thousand seven hundred twenty.
68 Some of the heads of fathers' households, when they came to Yahweh's house which is in Jerusalem, offered willingly for God's house to set it up in its place.
69 They gave according to their ability into the treasury of the work sixty-one thousand darics of gold,‡ five thousand minas§ of silver, and one hundred priests' garments.
70 So the priests and the Levites, with some of the people, the singers, the gatekeepers, and the temple servants, lived in their cities, and all Israel in their cities.

3

1 When the seventh month had come, and the children of Israel were in the cities, the people gathered themselves together as one man to Jerusalem.
2 Then Jeshua the son of Jozadak stood up with his brothers the priests and Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel and his relatives, and built the altar of the God of Israel, to offer burnt offerings on it, as it is written in the law of Moses the man of God.
3 In spite of their fear because of the peoples of the surrounding lands, they set the altar on its base; and they offered burnt offerings on it to Yahweh, even burnt offerings morning and evening.
4 They kept the feast of booths, as it is written, and offered the daily burnt offerings by number, according to the ordinance, as the duty of every day required;
5 and afterward the continual burnt offering, the offerings of the new moons, of all the set feasts of Yahweh that were consecrated, and of everyone who willingly offered a free will offering to Yahweh.
6 From the first day of the seventh month, they began to offer burnt offerings to Yahweh; but the foundation of Yahweh's temple was not yet laid.
7 They also gave money to the masons and to the carpenters. They also gave food, drink, and oil to the people of Sidon and Tyre to bring cedar trees from Lebanon to the sea, to Joppa, according to the grant that they had from Cyrus King of Persia.
8 Now in the second year of their coming to God's house at Jerusalem, in the second month, Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, Jeshua the son of Jozadak, and the rest of their brothers the priests and the Levites, and all those who had come out of the captivity to Jerusalem, began the work and appointed the Levites, from twenty years old and upward, to have the oversight of the work of Yahweh's house.

‡ **2:69** a daric was a gold coin issued by a Persian king, weighing about 8.4 grams or about 0.27 troy ounces each.
§ **2:69** A mina is about 600 grams or 1.3 U. S. pounds, so 5,000 minas is about 3 metric tons.

9 Then Jeshua stood with his sons and
his brothers, Kadmiel and his sons, the
sons of Judah, together to have the
oversight of the workmen in God's house:
the sons of Henadad, with their sons and
their brothers the Levites.
10 When the builders laid the
foundation of Yahweh's temple, they set
the priests in their vestments with
trumpets, with the Levites the sons of
Asaph with cymbals, to praise Yahweh,
according to the directions of David king
of Israel.
11 They sang to one another in praising
and giving thanks to Yahweh, "For he is
good, for his loving kindness endures
forever toward Israel." All the people
shouted with a great shout, when they
praised Yahweh, because the foundation
of Yahweh's house had been laid.
12 But many of the priests and Levites
and heads of fathers' households, the old
men who had seen the first house, when
the foundation of this house was laid
before their eyes, wept with a loud voice.
Many also shouted aloud for joy,
13 so that the people could not discern
the noise of the shout of joy from the noise
of the weeping of the people; for the
people shouted with a loud shout, and the
noise was heard far away.

4

1 Now when the adversaries of Judah
and Benjamin heard that the children of
the captivity were building a temple to
Yahweh, the God of Israel,
2 they came near to Zerubbabel, and to
the heads of fathers' households, and said
to them, "Let us build with you, for we
seek your God as you do; and we have
been sacrificing to him since the days of
Esar Haddon king of Assyria, who
brought us up here."
3 But Zerubbabel, Jeshua, and the rest of
the heads of fathers' households of Israel
said to them, "You have nothing to do with
us in building a house to our God; but we
ourselves together will build to Yahweh,
the God of Israel, as King Cyrus the king of
Persia has commanded us."
4 Then the people of the land weakened
the hands of the people of Judah, and
troubled them in building.
5 They hired counselors against them to
frustrate their purpose all the days of
Cyrus king of Persia, even until the reign
of Darius king of Persia.
6 In the reign of Ahasuerus, in the
beginning of his reign, they wrote an
accusation against the inhabitants of
Judah and Jerusalem.
7 In the days of Artaxerxes, Bishlam,
Mithredath, Tabeel, and the rest of his
companions wrote to Artaxerxes king of
Persia; and the writing of the letter was
written in Syrian and delivered in the
Syrian language.
8 Rehum the chancellor and Shimshai
the scribe wrote a letter against Jerusalem
to Artaxerxes the king as follows.
9 Then Rehum the chancellor, Shimshai
the scribe, and the rest of their
companions, the Dinaites, and the
Apharsathchites, the Tarpelites, the
Apharsites, the Archevites, the
Babylonians, the Shushanchites, the
Dehaites, the Elamites,
10 and the rest of the nations whom the
great and noble Osnappar brought over
and settled in the city of Samaria, and in
the rest of the country beyond the River,
and so forth, wrote.
11 This is the copy of the letter that they
sent:

> To King Artaxerxes, from your servants,
> the people beyond the River.
> 12 Be it known to the king that the
> Jews who came up from you have come
> to us to Jerusalem. They are building
> the rebellious and bad city, and have
> finished the walls and repaired the
> foundations.
> 13 Be it known now to the king that if
> this city is built and the walls finished,
> they will not pay tribute, custom, or toll,
> and in the end it will be hurtful to the
> kings.
> 14 Now because we eat the salt of the
> palace and it is not appropriate for us to
> see the king's dishonor, therefore we have
> sent and informed the king,

15 that search may be made in the
book of the records of your fathers. You
will see in the book of the records, and
know that this city is a rebellious city, and
hurtful to kings and provinces, and that
they have started rebellions within it in
the past. That is why this city was
destroyed.
16 We inform the king that if this city
is built and the walls finished, then you
will have no possession beyond the River.

17 Then the king sent an answer to
Rehum the chancellor, and to Shimshai
the scribe, and to the rest of their
companions who live in Samaria, and in
the rest of the country beyond the River:

Peace.

18 The letter which you sent to us has
been plainly read before me.
19 I decreed, and search has been
made, and it was found that this city has
made insurrection against kings in the
past, and that rebellion and revolts have
been made in it.
20 There have also been mighty kings
over Jerusalem who have ruled over all
the country beyond the River; and tribute,
custom, and toll was paid to them.
21 Make a decree now to cause these
men to cease, and that this city not be
built until a decree is made by me.
22 Be careful that you not be slack
doing so. Why should damage grow to the
hurt of the kings?

23 Then when the copy of King
Artaxerxes' letter was read before
Rehum, Shimshai the scribe, and their
companions, they went in haste to
Jerusalem to the Jews, and made them to
cease by force of arms.
24 Then work stopped on God's house
which is at Jerusalem. It stopped until the
second year of the reign of Darius king of
Persia.

5

1 Now the prophets, Haggai the prophet
and Zechariah the son of Iddo, prophesied
to the Jews who were in Judah and
Jerusalem. They prophesied to them in
the name of the God of Israel.
2 Then Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel,
and Jeshua the son of Jozadak rose up and
began to build God's house which is at
Jerusalem; and with them were the
prophets of God, helping them.
3 At the same time Tattenai, the
governor beyond the River, came to them,
with Shetharbozenai and their
companions, and asked them, "Who gave
you a decree to build this house and to
finish this wall?"
4 They also asked for the names of the
men who were making this building.
5 But the eye of their God was on the
elders of the Jews, and they didn't make
them cease until the matter should come
to Darius, and an answer should be
returned by letter concerning it.
6 The copy of the letter that Tattenai, the
governor beyond the River, and
Shetharbozenai, and his companions the
Apharsachites who were beyond the
River, sent to Darius the king follows.
7 They sent a letter to him, in which was
written:

To Darius the king, all peace.
8 Be it known to the king that we went
into the province of Judah, to the house
of the great God, which is being built
with great stones and timber is laid in
the walls. This work goes on with
diligence and prospers in their hands.
9 Then we asked those elders, and said
to them thus, "Who gave you a decree to
build this house, and to finish this wall?"
10 We asked them their names also, to
inform you that we might write the names
of the men who were at their head.
11 Thus they returned us answer,
saying, "We are the servants of the God of
heaven and earth and are building the
house that was built these many years
ago, which a great king of Israel built and
finished.
12 But after our fathers had provoked
the God of heaven to wrath, he gave them
into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of
Babylon, the Chaldean, who destroyed

this house and carried the people away into Babylon.

13 But in the first year of Cyrus king of Babylon, Cyrus the king made a decree to build this house of God.

14 The gold and silver vessels of God's house, which Nebuchadnezzar took out of the temple that was in Jerusalem and brought into the temple of Babylon, those Cyrus the king also took out of the temple of Babylon, and they were delivered to one whose name was Sheshbazzar, whom he had made governor.

15 He said to him, 'Take these vessels, go, put them in the temple that is in Jerusalem, and let God's house be built in its place.'

16 Then the same Sheshbazzar came and laid the foundations of God's house which is in Jerusalem. Since that time even until now it has been being built, and yet it is not completed.

17 Now therefore, if it seems good to the king, let a search be made in the king's treasure house, which is there at Babylon, whether it is so that a decree was made by Cyrus the king to build this house of God at Jerusalem; and let the king send his pleasure to us concerning this matter."

6

1 Then Darius the king made a decree, and the house of the archives, where the treasures were laid up in Babylon, was searched.

2 A scroll was found at Achmetha, in the palace that is in the province of Media, and in it this was written for a record:

3 In the first year of Cyrus the king, Cyrus the king made a decree: Concerning God's house at Jerusalem, let the house be built, the place where they offer sacrifices, and let its foundations be strongly laid, with its height sixty cubits† and its width sixty cubits;

4 with three courses of great stones and a course of new timber. Let the expenses be given out of the king's house.

5 Also let the gold and silver vessels of God's house, which Nebuchadnezzar took out of the temple which is at Jerusalem and brought to Babylon, be restored and brought again to the temple which is at Jerusalem, everything to its place. You shall put them in God's house.

6 Now therefore, Tattenai, governor beyond the River, Shetharbozenai, and your companions the Apharsachites, who are beyond the River, you must stay far from there.

7 Leave the work of this house of God alone; let the governor of the Jews and the elders of the Jews build this house of God in its place.

8 Moreover I make a decree regarding what you shall do for these elders of the Jews for the building of this house of God: that of the king's goods, even of the tribute beyond the River, expenses must be given with all diligence to these men, that they not be hindered.

9 That which they have need of, including young bulls, rams, and lambs, for burnt offerings to the God of heaven; also wheat, salt, wine, and oil, according to the word of the priests who are at Jerusalem, let it be given them day by day without fail,

10 that they may offer sacrifices of pleasant aroma to the God of heaven, and pray for the life of the king and of his sons.

11 I have also made a decree that whoever alters this message, let a beam be pulled out from his house, and let him be lifted up and fastened on it; and let his house be made a dunghill for this.

12 May the God who has caused his name to dwell there overthrow all kings and peoples who stretch out their hand to alter this, to destroy this house of God which is at Jerusalem. I Darius have made a decree. Let it be done with all diligence.

13 Then Tattenai, the governor beyond

† **6:3** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

the River, Shetharbozenai, and their companions did accordingly with all diligence, because Darius the king had sent a decree.
14 The elders of the Jews built and prospered, through the prophesying of Haggai the prophet and Zechariah the son of Iddo. They built and finished it, according to the commandment of the God of Israel, and according to the decree of Cyrus, Darius, and Artaxerxes king of Persia.
15 This house was finished on the third day of the month Adar, which was in the sixth year of the reign of Darius the king.
16 The children of Israel, the priests, the Levites, and the rest of the children of the captivity, kept the dedication of this house of God with joy.
17 They offered at the dedication of this house of God one hundred bulls, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs; and for a sin offering for all Israel, twelve male goats, according to the number of the tribes of Israel.
18 They set the priests in their divisions and the Levites in their courses, for the service of God which is at Jerusalem, as it is written in the book of Moses.
19 The children of the captivity kept the Passover on the fourteenth day of the first month.
20 Because the priests and the Levites had purified themselves together, all of them were pure. They killed the Passover for all the children of the captivity, for their brothers the priests, and for themselves.
21 The children of Israel who had returned out of the captivity, and all who had separated themselves to them from the filthiness of the nations of the land to seek Yahweh, the God of Israel, ate,
22 and kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days with joy; because Yahweh had made them joyful, and had turned the heart of the king of Assyria to them, to strengthen their hands in the work of God, the God of Israel's house.

7

1 Now after these things, in the reign of Artaxerxes king of Persia, Ezra the son of Seraiah, the son of Azariah, the son of Hilkiah,
2 the son of Shallum, the son of Zadok, the son of Ahitub,
3 the son of Amariah, the son of Azariah, the son of Meraioth,
4 the son of Zerahiah, the son of Uzzi, the son of Bukki,
5 the son of Abishua, the son of Phinehas, the son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the chief priest—
6 this Ezra went up from Babylon. He was a skilled scribe in the law of Moses, which Yahweh, the God of Israel, had given; and the king granted him all his request, according to Yahweh his God's hand on him.
7 Some of the children of Israel, including some of the priests, the Levites, the singers, the gatekeepers, and the temple servants went up to Jerusalem in the seventh year of Artaxerxes the king.
8 He came to Jerusalem in the fifth month, which was in the seventh year of the king.
9 For on the first day of the first month he began to go up from Babylon; and on the first day of the fifth month he came to Jerusalem, according to the good hand of his God on him.
10 For Ezra had set his heart to seek Yahweh's law, and to do it, and to teach statutes and ordinances in Israel.

11 Now this is the copy of the letter that King Artaxerxes gave to Ezra the priest, the scribe, even the scribe of the words of Yahweh's commandments, and of his statutes to Israel:

12 Artaxerxes, king of kings,
To Ezra the priest, the scribe of the law of the perfect God of heaven.
Now
13 I make a decree that all those of the people of Israel and their priests and the Levites in my realm, who intend of their own free will to go to Jerusalem, go with you.
14 Because you are sent by the king and his seven counselors to inquire concerning Judah and Jerusalem,

according to the law of your God which is in your hand,
15 and to carry the silver and gold, which the king and his counselors have freely offered to the God of Israel, whose habitation is in Jerusalem,
16 and all the silver and gold that you will find in all the province of Babylon, with the free will offering of the people and of the priests, offering willingly for the house of their God which is in Jerusalem.
17 Therefore you shall with all diligence buy with this money bulls, rams, and lambs with their meal offerings and their drink offerings, and shall offer them on the altar of the house of your God which is in Jerusalem.
18 Whatever seems good to you and to your brothers to do with the rest of the silver and the gold, do that according to the will of your God.
19 The vessels that are given to you for the service of the house of your God, deliver before the God of Jerusalem.
20 Whatever more will be needed for the house of your God, which you may have occasion to give, give it out of the king's treasure house.
21 I, even I, Artaxerxes the king, make a decree to all the treasurers who are beyond the River, that whatever Ezra the priest, the scribe of the law of the God of heaven, requires of you, it shall be done with all diligence,
22 up to one hundred talents† of silver, and to one hundred cors‡ of wheat, and to one hundred baths§ of wine, and to one hundred baths of oil, and salt without prescribing how much.
23 Whatever is commanded by the God of heaven, let it be done exactly for the house of the God of heaven; for why should there be wrath against the realm of the king and his sons?
24 Also we inform you that it shall not be lawful to impose tribute, custom, or toll on any of the priests, Levites, singers, gatekeepers, temple servants, or laborers of this house of God.
25 You, Ezra, according to the wisdom of your God that is in your hand, appoint magistrates and judges who may judge all the people who are beyond the River, who all know the laws of your God; and teach him who doesn't know them.
26 Whoever will not do the law of your God and the law of the king, let judgment be executed on him with all diligence, whether it is to death, or to banishment, or to confiscation of goods, or to imprisonment.

27 Blessed be Yahweh, the God of our fathers, who has put such a thing as this in the king's heart, to beautify Yahweh's house which is in Jerusalem;
28 and has extended loving kindness to me before the king and his counselors, and before all the king's mighty princes. I was strengthened according to Yahweh my God's hand on me, and I gathered together chief men out of Israel to go up with me.

8

1 Now these are the heads of their fathers' households, and this is the genealogy of those who went up with me from Babylon, in the reign of Artaxerxes the king:
2 Of the sons of Phinehas, Gershom.
Of the sons of Ithamar, Daniel.
Of the sons of David, Hattush.
3 Of the sons of Shecaniah, of the sons of Parosh, Zechariah; and with him were listed by genealogy of the males one hundred fifty.
4 Of the sons of Pahathmoab, Eliehoenai the son of Zerahiah; and with him two hundred males.
5 Of the sons of Shecaniah, the son of Jahaziel; and with him three hundred males.

† **7:22** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces ‡ **7:22** 1 cor is the same as a homer, or about 55.9 U. S. gallons (liquid) or 211 liters or 6 bushels. § **7:22** 1 bath is one tenth of a cor, or about 5.6 U. S. gallons or 21 liters or 2.4 pecks. 100 baths would be about 2,100 liters.

6 Of the sons of Adin, Ebed the son of
Jonathan; and with him fifty males.
7 Of the sons of Elam, Jeshaiah the son of
Athaliah; and with him seventy
males.
8 Of the sons of Shephatiah, Zebadiah
the son of Michael; and with him
eighty males.
9 Of the sons of Joab, Obadiah the son of
Jehiel; and with him two hundred
eighteen males.
10 Of the sons of Shelomith, the son of
Josiphiah; and with him one hundred
sixty males.
11 Of the sons of Bebai, Zechariah the
son of Bebai; and with him
twenty-eight males.
12 Of the sons of Azgad, Johanan the son
of Hakkatan; and with him one
hundred ten males.
13 Of the sons of Adonikam, who were
the last, their names are: Eliphelet,
Jeuel, and Shemaiah; and with them
sixty males.
14 Of the sons of Bigvai, Uthai and
Zabbud; and with them seventy
males.
15 I gathered them together to the river
that runs to Ahava; and there we
encamped three days. Then I looked
around at the people and the priests, and
found there were none of the sons of Levi.
16 Then I sent for Eliezer, for Ariel, for
Shemaiah, for Elnathan, for Jarib, for
Elnathan, for Nathan, for Zechariah, and
for Meshullam, chief men; also for Joiarib
and for Elnathan, who were teachers.
17 I sent them out to Iddo the chief at the
place Casiphia; and I told them what they
should tell Iddo and his brothers the
temple servants at the place Casiphia, that
they should bring to us ministers for the
house of our God.
18 According to the good hand of our
God on us they brought us a man of
discretion, of the sons of Mahli, the son of
Levi, the son of Israel, namely Sherebiah,
with his sons and his brothers, eighteen;
19 and Hashabiah, and with him
Jeshaiah of the sons of Merari, his
brothers and their sons, twenty;
20 and of the temple servants, whom
David and the princes had given for the
service of the Levites, two hundred
twenty temple servants. All of them were
mentioned by name.
21 Then I proclaimed a fast there at the
river Ahava, that we might humble
ourselves before our God, to seek from
him a straight way for us, for our little
ones, and for all our possessions.
22 For I was ashamed to ask of the king a
band of soldiers and horsemen to help us
against the enemy on the way, because we
had spoken to the king, saying, “The hand
of our God is on all those who seek him,
for good; but his power and his wrath is
against all those who forsake him.”
23 So we fasted and begged our God for
this, and he granted our request.
24 Then I set apart twelve of the chiefs of
the priests, even Sherebiah, Hashabiah,
and ten of their brothers with them,
25 and weighed to them the silver, the
gold, and the vessels, even the offering for
the house of our God, which the king, his
counselors, his princes, and all Israel
there present, had offered.
26 I weighed into their hand six hundred
fifty talents of silver,† one hundred talents
of silver vessels, one hundred talents of
gold,
27 twenty bowls of gold weighing one
thousand darics,‡ and two vessels of fine
bright bronze, precious as gold.
28 I said to them, “You are holy to
Yahweh, and the vessels are holy. The
silver and the gold are a free will offering
to Yahweh, the God of your fathers.
29 Watch and keep them until you weigh
them before the chiefs of the priests, the
Levites, and the princes of the fathers’
households of Israel at Jerusalem, in the
rooms of Yahweh’s house.”
30 So the priests and the Levites
received the weight of the silver, the gold,
and the vessels, to bring them to
Jerusalem to the house of our God.

† **8:26** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces ‡ **8:27** a daric was a gold coin issued by a Persian king, weighing about 8.4 grams or about 0.27 troy ounces each.

31 Then we departed from the river
Ahava on the twelfth day of the first
month, to go to Jerusalem. The hand of
our God was on us, and he delivered us
from the hand of the enemy and the
bandits by the way.
32 We came to Jerusalem, and stayed
there three days.
33 On the fourth day the silver and the
gold and the vessels were weighed in the
house of our God into the hand of
Meremoth the son of Uriah the priest; and
with him was Eleazar the son of Phinehas;
and with them were Jozabad the son of
Jeshua, and Noadiah the son of Binnui,
the Levites.
34 Everything was counted and
weighed; and all the weight was written
at that time.
35 The children of the captivity, who had
come out of exile, offered burnt offerings
to the God of Israel: twelve bulls for all
Israel, ninety-six rams, seventy-seven
lambs, and twelve male goats for a sin
offering. All this was a burnt offering to
Yahweh.
36 They delivered the king's
commissions to the king's local governors
and to the governors beyond the River. So
they supported the people and God's
house.

9

1 Now when these things were done, the
princes came near to me, saying, "The
people of Israel, the priests, and the
Levites have not separated themselves
from the peoples of the lands, following
their abominations, even those of the
Canaanites, the Hittites, the Perizzites, the
Jebusites, the Ammonites, the Moabites,
the Egyptians, and the Amorites.
2 For they have taken of their daughters
for themselves and for their sons, so that
the holy offspring have mixed themselves
with the peoples of the lands. Yes, the
hand of the princes and rulers has been
chief in this trespass."
3 When I heard this thing, I tore my
garment and my robe, and pulled the hair
out of my head and of my beard, and sat
down confounded.
4 Then everyone who trembled at the
words of the God of Israel were assembled
to me because of the trespass of the exiles;
and I sat confounded until the evening
offering.
5 At the evening offering I rose up from
my humiliation, even with my garment
and my robe torn; and I fell on my knees,
and spread out my hands to Yahweh my
God;
6 and I said, "My God, I am ashamed and
blush to lift up my face to you, my God, for
our iniquities have increased over our
head, and our guiltiness has grown up to
the heavens.
7 Since the days of our fathers we have
been exceedingly guilty to this day; and
for our iniquities we, our kings, and our
priests have been delivered into the hand
of the kings of the lands, to the sword, to
captivity, to plunder, and to confusion of
face, as it is this day.
8 Now for a little moment grace has
been shown from Yahweh our God, to
leave us a remnant to escape, and to give
us a stake in his holy place, that our God
may lighten our eyes, and revive us a little
in our bondage.
9 For we are bondservants; yet our God
has not forsaken us in our bondage, but
has extended loving kindness to us in the
sight of the kings of Persia, to revive us, to
set up the house of our God, and to repair
its ruins, and to give us a wall in Judah
and in Jerusalem.
10 "Now, our God, what shall we say
after this? For we have forsaken your
commandments,
11 which you have commanded by your
servants the prophets, saying, 'The land to
which you go to possess is an unclean
land through the uncleanness of the
peoples of the lands, through their
abominations, which have filled it from
one end to another with their filthiness.
12 Now therefore don't give your
daughters to their sons. Don't take their
daughters to your sons, nor seek their
peace or their prosperity forever, that you
may be strong and eat the good of the

land, and leave it for an inheritance to your children forever.'
13 "After all that has come on us for our evil deeds and for our great guilt, since you, our God, have punished us less than our iniquities deserve, and have given us such a remnant,
14 shall we again break your commandments, and join ourselves with the peoples that do these abominations? Wouldn't you be angry with us until you had consumed us, so that there would be no remnant, nor any to escape?
15 Yahweh, the God of Israel, you are righteous; for we are left a remnant that has escaped, as it is today. Behold,† we are before you in our guiltiness; for no one can stand before you because of this."

10

1 Now while Ezra prayed and made confession, weeping and casting himself down before God's house, there was gathered together to him out of Israel a very great assembly of men and women and children; for the people wept very bitterly.
2 Shecaniah the son of Jehiel, one of the sons of Elam, answered Ezra, "We have trespassed against our God, and have married foreign women of the peoples of the land. Yet now there is hope for Israel concerning this thing.
3 Now therefore let's make a covenant with our God to put away all the wives and those who are born of them, according to the counsel of my lord and of those who tremble at the commandment of our God. Let it be done according to the law.
4 Arise, for the matter belongs to you and we are with you. Be courageous, and do it."
5 Then Ezra arose, and made the chiefs of the priests, the Levites, and all Israel to swear that they would do according to this word. So they swore.
6 Then Ezra rose up from before God's house, and went into the room of Jehohanan the son of Eliashib. When he came there, he didn't eat bread or drink water, for he mourned because of the trespass of the exiles.
7 They made a proclamation throughout Judah and Jerusalem to all the children of the captivity, that they should gather themselves together to Jerusalem;
8 and that whoever didn't come within three days, according to the counsel of the princes and the elders, all his possessions should be forfeited, and he himself separated from the assembly of the captivity.
9 Then all the men of Judah and Benjamin gathered themselves together to Jerusalem within the three days. It was the ninth month, on the twentieth day of the month; and all the people sat in the wide place in front of God's house, trembling because of this matter, and because of the great rain.
10 Ezra the priest stood up and said to them, "You have trespassed, and have married foreign women, increasing the guilt of Israel.
11 Now therefore make confession to Yahweh, the God of your fathers and do his pleasure. Separate yourselves from the peoples of the land and from the foreign women."
12 Then all the assembly answered with a loud voice, "We must do as you have said concerning us.
13 But the people are many, and it is a time of much rain, and we are not able to stand outside. This is not a work of one day or two, for we have greatly transgressed in this matter.
14 Now let our princes be appointed for all the assembly, and let all those who are in our cities who have married foreign women come at appointed times, and with them the elders of every city and its judges, until the fierce wrath of our God is turned from us, until this matter is resolved."
15 Only Jonathan the son of Asahel and Jahzeiah the son of Tikvah stood up against this; and Meshullam and Shabbethai the Levite helped them.

† **9:15** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

16 The children of the captivity did so.
Ezra the priest, with certain heads of
fathers' households, after their fathers'
houses, and all of them by their names,
were set apart; and they sat down in the
first day of the tenth month to examine
the matter.
17 They finished with all the men who
had married foreign women by the first
day of the first month.
18 Among the sons of the priests there
were found who had married foreign
women:
of the sons of Jeshua, the son of Jozadak,
and his brothers: Maaseiah, Eliezer,
Jarib, and Gedaliah.
19 They gave their hand that they would
put away their wives; and being guilty,
they offered a ram of the flock for their
guilt.
20 Of the sons of Immer: Hanani and
Zebadiah.
21 Of the sons of Harim: Maaseiah,
Elijah, Shemaiah, Jehiel, and Uzziah.
22 Of the sons of Pashhur: Elioenai,
Maaseiah, Ishmael, Nethanel,
Jozabad, and Elasah.
23 Of the Levites: Jozabad, Shimei,
Kelaiah (also called Kelita),
Pethahiah, Judah, and Eliezer.
24 Of the singers: Eliashib.
Of the gatekeepers: Shallum, Telem,
and Uri.
25 Of Israel: Of the sons of Parosh:
Ramiah, Izziah, Malchijah, Mijamin,
Eleazar, Malchijah, and Benaiah.
26 Of the sons of Elam: Mattaniah,
Zechariah, Jehiel, Abdi, Jeremoth, and
Elijah.
27 Of the sons of Zattu: Elioenai,
Eliashib, Mattaniah, Jeremoth, Zabad,
and Aziza.
28 Of the sons of Bebai: Jehohanan,
Hananiah, Zabbai, and Athlai.
29 Of the sons of Bani: Meshullam,
Malluch, Adaiah, Jashub, Sheal, and
Jeremoth.
30 Of the sons of Pahathmoab: Adna,
Chelal, Benaiah, Maaseiah,
Mattaniah, Bezalel, Binnui, and
Manasseh.
31 Of the sons of Harim: Eliezer, Isshijah,
Malchijah, Shemaiah, Shimeon,
32 Benjamin, Malluch, and Shemariah.
33 Of the sons of Hashum: Mattenai,
Mattattah, Zabad, Eliphelet, Jeremai,
Manasseh, and Shimei.
34 Of the sons of Bani: Maadai, Amram,
Uel,
35 Benaiah, Bedeiah, Cheluhi,
36 Vaniah, Meremoth, Eliashib,
37 Mattaniah, Mattenai, Jaasu,
38 Bani, Binnui, Shimei,
39 Shelemiah, Nathan, Adaiah,
40 Machnadebai, Shashai, Sharai,
41 Azarel, Shelemiah, Shemariah,
42 Shallum, Amariah, and Joseph.
43 Of the sons of Nebo: Jeiel, Mattithiah,
Zabad, Zebina, Iddo, Joel, and
Benaiah.
44 All these had taken foreign wives.
Some of them had wives by whom they
had children.

The Book of Nehemiah

1 The words of Nehemiah the son of Hacaliah.

Now in the month Chislev, in the twentieth year, as I was in Susa the palace,
2 Hanani, one of my brothers, came, he and certain men out of Judah; and I asked them about the Jews who had escaped, who were left of the captivity, and concerning Jerusalem.
3 They said to me, "The remnant who are left of the captivity there in the province are in great affliction and reproach. The wall of Jerusalem is also broken down, and its gates are burned with fire."
4 When I heard these words, I sat down and wept, and mourned several days; and I fasted and prayed before the God† of heaven,
5 and said, "I beg you, Yahweh,‡ the God of heaven, the great and awesome God who keeps covenant and loving kindness with those who love him and keep his commandments,
6 let your ear now be attentive and your eyes open, that you may listen to the prayer of your servant which I pray before you at this time, day and night, for the children of Israel your servants, while I confess the sins of the children of Israel which we have sinned against you. Yes, I and my father's house have sinned.
7 We have dealt very corruptly against you, and have not kept the commandments, nor the statutes, nor the ordinances, which you commanded your servant Moses.
8 "Remember, I beg you, the word that you commanded your servant Moses, saying, 'If you trespass, I will scatter you among the peoples;
9 but if you return to me, and keep my commandments and do them, though your outcasts were in the uttermost part of the heavens, yet I will gather them from there, and will bring them to the place that I have chosen, to cause my name to dwell there.'
10 "Now these are your servants and your people, whom you have redeemed by your great power and by your strong hand.
11 Lord,§ I beg you, let your ear be attentive now to the prayer of your servant, and to the prayer of your servants who delight to fear your name; and please prosper your servant today, and grant him mercy in the sight of this man."

Now I was cup bearer to the king.

2

1 In the month Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artaxerxes the king, when wine was before him, I picked up the wine, and gave it to the king. Now I had not been sad before in his presence.
2 The king said to me, "Why is your face sad, since you are not sick? This is nothing else but sorrow of heart."

Then I was very much afraid.
3 I said to the king, "Let the king live forever! Why shouldn't my face be sad, when the city, the place of my fathers' tombs, lies waste, and its gates have been consumed with fire?"
4 Then the king said to me, "What is your request?"

So I prayed to the God of heaven.
5 I said to the king, "If it pleases the king, and if your servant has found favor in your sight, I ask that you would send me to Judah, to the city of my fathers' tombs, that I may build it."
6 The king said to me (the queen was also sitting by him), "How long will your journey be? When will you return?"

So it pleased the king to send me, and I set a time for him.
7 Moreover I said to the king, "If it pleases the king, let letters be given me to the governors beyond the River, that they

† **1:4** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). ‡ **1:5** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. § **1:11** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai."

may let me pass through until I come to Judah;
8 and a letter to Asaph the keeper of the king's forest, that he may give me timber to make beams for the gates of the citadel by the temple, for the wall of the city, and for the house that I will occupy."

The king granted my requests, because of the good hand of my God on me.
9 Then I came to the governors beyond the River, and gave them the king's letters. Now the king had sent captains of the army and horsemen with me.
10 When Sanballat the Horonite and Tobiah the Ammonite servant heard of it, it grieved them exceedingly, because a man had come to seek the welfare of the children of Israel.
11 So I came to Jerusalem, and was there three days.
12 I arose in the night, I and a few men with me. I didn't tell anyone what my God put into my heart to do for Jerusalem. There wasn't any animal with me except the animal that I rode on.
13 I went out by night by the valley gate toward the jackal's well, then to the dung gate; and I inspected the walls of Jerusalem, which were broken down, and its gates were consumed with fire.
14 Then I went on to the spring gate and to the king's pool, but there was no place for the animal that was under me to pass.
15 Then I went up in the night by the brook and inspected the wall; and I turned back, and entered by the valley gate, and so returned.
16 The rulers didn't know where I went, or what I did. I had not as yet told it to the Jews, nor to the priests, nor to the nobles, nor to the rulers, nor to the rest who did the work.
17 Then I said to them, "You see the bad situation that we are in, how Jerusalem lies waste, and its gates are burned with fire. Come, let's build up the wall of Jerusalem, that we won't be disgraced."
18 I told them about the hand of my God which was good on me, and also about the king's words that he had spoken to me.

They said, "Let's rise up and build." So they strengthened their hands for the good work.
19 But when Sanballat the Horonite, Tobiah the Ammonite servant, and Geshem the Arabian, heard it, they ridiculed us and despised us, and said, "What is this thing that you are doing? Will you rebel against the king?"
20 Then I answered them, and said to them, "The God of heaven will prosper us. Therefore we, his servants, will arise and build; but you have no portion, nor right, nor memorial in Jerusalem."

3

1 Then Eliashib the high priest rose up with his brothers the priests, and they built the sheep gate. They sanctified it, and set up its doors. They sanctified it even to the tower of Hammeah, to the tower of Hananel.
2 Next to him the men of Jericho built. Next to them Zaccur the son of Imri built.
3 The sons of Hassenaah built the fish gate. They laid its beams, and set up its doors, its bolts, and its bars.
4 Next to them, Meremoth the son of Uriah, the son of Hakkoz made repairs. Next to them, Meshullam the son of Berechiah, the son of Meshezabel made repairs. Next to them, Zadok the son of Baana made repairs.
5 Next to them, the Tekoites made repairs; but their nobles didn't put their necks to the Lord's work.
6 Joiada the son of Paseah and Meshullam the son of Besodeiah repaired the old gate. They laid its beams and set up its doors, its bolts, and its bars.
7 Next to them, Melatiah the Gibeonite and Jadon the Meronothite, the men of Gibeon and of Mizpah, repaired the residence of the governor beyond the River.
8 Next to him, Uzziel the son of Harhaiah, goldsmiths, made repairs. Next to him, Hananiah, one of the perfumers, made repairs, and they fortified Jerusalem even to the wide wall.

9 Next to them, Rephaiah the son of Hur,
the ruler of half the district of Jerusalem,
made repairs.
10 Next to them, Jedaiah the son of
Harumaph made repairs across from his
house. Next to him, Hattush the son of
Hashabneiah made repairs.
11 Malchijah the son of Harim and
Hasshub the son of Pahathmoab repaired
another portion and the tower of the
furnaces.
12 Next to him, Shallum the son of
Hallohesh, the ruler of half the district of
Jerusalem, he and his daughters made
repairs.
13 Hanun and the inhabitants of Zanoah
repaired the valley gate. They built it, and
set up its doors, its bolts, and its bars, and
one thousand cubits† of the wall to the
dung gate.
14 Malchijah the son of Rechab, the ruler
of the district of Beth Haccherem,
repaired the dung gate. He built it, and set
up its doors, its bolts, and its bars.
15 Shallun the son of Colhozeh, the ruler
of the district of Mizpah, repaired the
spring gate. He built it, covered it, and set
up its doors, its bolts, and its bars; and he
repaired the wall of the pool of Shelah by
the king's garden, even to the stairs that
go down from David's city.
16 After him, Nehemiah the son of
Azbuk, the ruler of half the district of Beth
Zur, made repairs to the place opposite
the tombs of David, and to the pool that
was made, and to the house of the mighty
men.
17 After him, the Levites—Rehum the
son of Bani made repairs. Next to him,
Hashabiah, the ruler of half the district of
Keilah, made repairs for his district.
18 After him, their brothers, Bavvai the
son of Henadad, the ruler of half the
district of Keilah made repairs.
19 Next to him, Ezer the son of Jeshua,
the ruler of Mizpah, repaired another
portion across from the ascent to the
armory at the turning of the wall.
20 After him, Baruch the son of Zabbai
earnestly repaired another portion, from
the turning of the wall to the door of the
house of Eliashib the high priest.
21 After him, Meremoth the son of Uriah
the son of Hakkoz repaired another
portion, from the door of the house of
Eliashib even to the end of the house of
Eliashib.
22 After him, the priests, the men of the
surrounding area made repairs.
23 After them, Benjamin and Hasshub
made repairs across from their house.
After them, Azariah the son of Maaseiah
the son of Ananiah made repairs beside
his own house.
24 After him, Binnui the son of Henadad
repaired another portion, from the house
of Azariah to the turning of the wall, and
to the corner.
25 Palal the son of Uzai made repairs
opposite the turning of the wall, and the
tower that stands out from the upper
house of the king, which is by the court of
the guard. After him Pedaiah the son of
Parosh made repairs.
26 (Now the temple servants lived in
Ophel, to the place opposite the water gate
toward the east, and the tower that stands
out.)
27 After him the Tekoites repaired
another portion, opposite the great tower
that stands out, and to the wall of Ophel.
28 Above the horse gate, the priests
made repairs, everyone across from his
own house.
29 After them, Zadok the son of Immer
made repairs across from his own house.
After him, Shemaiah the son of Shecaniah,
the keeper of the east gate, made repairs.
30 After him, Hananiah the son of
Shelemiah, and Hanun, the sixth son of
Zalaph, repaired another portion. After
him, Meshullam the son of Berechiah
made repairs across from his room.
31 After him, Malchijah, one of the
goldsmiths to the house of the temple
servants, and of the merchants, made
repairs opposite the gate of Hammiphkad
and to the ascent of the corner.
32 Between the ascent of the corner and
the sheep gate, the goldsmiths and the

† **3:13** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

merchants made repairs.

4

1 But when Sanballat heard that we
were building the wall, he was angry, and
was very indignant, and mocked the Jews.
2 He spoke before his brothers and the
army of Samaria, and said, “What are
these feeble Jews doing? Will they fortify
themselves? Will they sacrifice? Will they
finish in a day? Will they revive the stones
out of the heaps of rubbish, since they are
burned?”
3 Now Tobiah the Ammonite was by
him, and he said, “What they are building,
if a fox climbed up it, he would break
down their stone wall.”
4 “Hear, our God, for we are despised.
Turn back their reproach on their own
head. Give them up for a plunder in a
land of captivity.
5 Don’t cover their iniquity. Don’t let
their sin be blotted out from before you;
for they have insulted the builders.”
6 So we built the wall; and all the wall
was joined together to half its height, for
the people had a mind to work.
7 But when Sanballat, Tobiah, the
Arabians, the Ammonites, and the
Ashdodites heard that the repairing of the
walls of Jerusalem went forward, and that
the breaches began to be filled, they were
very angry;
8 and they all conspired together to
come and fight against Jerusalem, and to
cause confusion among us.
9 But we made our prayer to our God,
and set a watch against them day and
night because of them.
10 Judah said, “The strength of the
bearers of burdens is fading and there is
much rubble, so that we are not able to
build the wall.”
11 Our adversaries said, “They will not
know or see, until we come in among
them and kill them, and cause the work to
cease.”
12 When the Jews who lived by them
came, they said to us ten times from all
places, “Wherever you turn, they will
attack us.”
13 Therefore I set guards in the lowest
parts of the space behind the wall, in the
open places. I set the people by family
groups with their swords, their spears,
and their bows.
14 I looked, and rose up, and said to the
nobles, to the rulers, and to the rest of the
people, “Don’t be afraid of them!
Remember the Lord, who is great and
awesome, and fight for your brothers,
your sons, your daughters, your wives,
and your houses.”
15 When our enemies heard that it was
known to us, and God had brought their
counsel to nothing, all of us returned to
the wall, everyone to his work.
16 From that time forth, half of my
servants did the work, and half of them
held the spears, the shields, the bows, and
the coats of mail; and the rulers were
behind all the house of Judah.
17 Those who built the wall, and those
who bore burdens loaded themselves;
everyone with one of his hands did the
work, and with the other held his weapon.
18 Among the builders, everyone wore
his sword at his side, and so built. He who
sounded the trumpet was by me.
19 I said to the nobles, and to the rulers
and to the rest of the people, “The work is
great and widely spread out, and we are
separated on the wall, far from one
another.
20 Wherever you hear the sound of the
trumpet, rally there to us. Our God will
fight for us.”
21 So we did the work. Half of the people
held the spears from the rising of the
morning until the stars appeared.
22 Likewise at the same time I said to the
people, “Let everyone with his servant
lodge within Jerusalem, that in the night
they may be a guard to us, and may labor
in the day.”
23 So neither I, nor my brothers, nor my
servants, nor the men of the guard who
followed me took off our clothes.
Everyone took his weapon to the water.

5

1 Then there arose a great cry of the
people and of their wives against their

brothers the Jews.
2 For there were some who said, “We, our sons and our daughters, are many. Let us get grain, that we may eat and live.”
3 There were also some who said, “We are mortgaging our fields, our vineyards, and our houses. Let us get grain, because of the famine.”
4 There were also some who said, “We have borrowed money for the king’s tribute using our fields and our vineyards as collateral.
5 Yet now our flesh is as the flesh of our brothers, our children as their children. Behold,† we bring our sons and our daughters into bondage to be servants, and some of our daughters have been brought into bondage. It is also not in our power to help it, because other men have our fields and our vineyards.”
6 I was very angry when I heard their cry and these words.
7 Then I consulted with myself, and contended with the nobles and the rulers, and said to them, “You exact usury, everyone of his brother.” I held a great assembly against them.
8 I said to them, “We, after our ability, have redeemed our brothers the Jews that were sold to the nations; and would you even sell your brothers, and should they be sold to us?” Then they held their peace, and found not a word to say.
9 Also I said, “The thing that you do is not good. Shouldn’t you walk in the fear of our God because of the reproach of the nations, our enemies?
10 I likewise, my brothers and my servants, lend them money and grain. Please let us stop this usury.
11 Please restore to them, even today, their fields, their vineyards, their olive groves, and their houses, also the hundredth part of the money, and of the grain, the new wine, and the oil, that you are charging them.”
12 Then they said, “We will restore them, and will require nothing of them. We will do so, even as you say.”

Then I called the priests, and took an oath of them, that they would do according to this promise.
13 Also I shook out my lap, and said, “So may God shake out every man from his house, and from his labor, that doesn’t perform this promise; even may he be shaken out and emptied like this.”

All the assembly said, “Amen,” and praised Yahweh. The people did according to this promise.

14 Moreover from the time that I was appointed to be their governor in the land of Judah, from the twentieth year even to the thirty-second year of Artaxerxes the king, that is, twelve years, I and my brothers have not eaten the bread of the governor.
15 But the former governors who were before me were supported by the people, and took bread and wine from them, plus forty shekels‡ of silver; yes, even their servants ruled over the people, but I didn’t do so, because of the fear of God.
16 Yes, I also continued in the work of this wall. We didn’t buy any land. All my servants were gathered there to the work.
17 Moreover there were at my table, of the Jews and the rulers, one hundred fifty men, in addition to those who came to us from among the nations that were around us.
18 Now that which was prepared for one day was one ox and six choice sheep. Also fowls were prepared for me, and once in ten days a store of all sorts of wine. Yet for all this, I didn’t demand the governor’s pay, because the bondage was heavy on this people.
19 Remember me, my God, for all the good that I have done for this people.

6

1 Now when it was reported to Sanballat, Tobiah, Geshem the Arabian, and to the rest of our enemies that I had built the wall, and that there was no breach left in it (though even to that time I had not set up the doors in the gates),

† **5:5** “Behold”, from “הִנֵּה”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
‡ **5:15** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

2 Sanballat and Geshem sent to me,
saying, “Come! Let’s meet together in the
villages in the plain of Ono.” But they
intended to harm me.
3 I sent messengers to them, saying, “I
am doing a great work, so that I can’t
come down. Why should the work cease
while I leave it and come down to you?”
4 They sent to me four times like this;
and I answered them the same way.
5 Then Sanballat sent his servant to me
the same way the fifth time with an open
letter in his hand,
6 in which was written, “It is reported
among the nations, and Gashmu says it,
that you and the Jews intend to rebel.
Because of that, you are building the wall.
You would be their king, according to
these words.
7 You have also appointed prophets to
proclaim of you at Jerusalem, saying,
‘There is a king in Judah!’ Now it will be
reported to the king according to these
words. Come now therefore, and let’s take
counsel together.”
8 Then I sent to him, saying, “There are
no such things done as you say, but you
imagine them out of your own heart.”
9 For they all would have made us
afraid, saying, “Their hands will be
weakened from the work, that it not be
done.” But now, strengthen my hands.
10 I went to the house of Shemaiah the
son of Delaiah the son of Mehetabel, who
was shut in at his home; and he said, “Let
us meet together in God’s house, within
the temple, and let’s shut the doors of the
temple; for they will come to kill you. Yes,
in the night they will come to kill you.”
11 I said, “Should a man like me flee?
Who is there that, being such as I, would
go into the temple to save his life? I will
not go in.”
12 I discerned, and behold, God had not
sent him, but he pronounced this
prophecy against me. Tobiah and
Sanballat had hired him.
13 He was hired so that I would be
afraid, do so, and sin, and that they might
have material for an evil report, that they
might reproach me.
14 “Remember, my God, Tobiah and
Sanballat according to these their works,
and also the prophetess Noadiah and the
rest of the prophets that would have put
me in fear.”
15 So the wall was finished in the
twenty-fifth day of Elul, in fifty-two days.
16 When all our enemies heard of it, all
the nations that were around us were
afraid, and they lost their confidence; for
they perceived that this work was done by
our God.
17 Moreover in those days the nobles of
Judah sent many letters to Tobiah, and
Tobiah’s letters came to them.
18 For there were many in Judah sworn
to him because he was the son-in-law of
Shecaniah the son of Arah; and his son
Jehohanan had taken the daughter of
Meshullam the son of Berechiah as wife.
19 Also they spoke of his good deeds
before me, and reported my words to him.
Tobiah sent letters to put me in fear.

7

1 Now when the wall was built and I had
set up the doors, and the gatekeepers and
the singers and the Levites were
appointed,
2 I put my brother Hanani, and
Hananiah the governor of the fortress, in
charge of Jerusalem; for he was a faithful
man and feared God above many.
3 I said to them, “Don’t let the gates of
Jerusalem be opened until the sun is hot;
and while they stand guard, let them shut
the doors, and you bar them; and appoint
watches of the inhabitants of Jerusalem,
everyone in his watch, with everyone
near his house.”
4 Now the city was wide and large; but
the people were few therein, and the
houses were not built.
5 My God put into my heart to gather
together the nobles, and the rulers, and
the people, that they might be listed by
genealogy. I found the book of the
genealogy of those who came up at the
first, and I found this written in it:
6 These are the children of the province
who went up out of the captivity of those
who had been carried away, whom

Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon had
carried away, and who returned to
Jerusalem and to Judah, everyone to his
city,
7 who came with Zerubbabel, Jeshua,
Nehemiah, Azariah, Raamiah, Nahamani,
Mordecai, Bilshan, Mispereth, Bigvai,
Nehum, and Baanah.

The number of the men of the people of
Israel:
8 The children of Parosh: two thousand
one hundred seventy-two.
9 The children of Shephatiah: three
hundred seventy-two.
10 The children of Arah: six hundred
fifty-two.
11 The children of Pahathmoab, of the
children of Jeshua and Joab: two
thousand eight hundred eighteen.
12 The children of Elam: one thousand
two hundred fifty-four.
13 The children of Zattu: eight hundred
forty-five.
14 The children of Zaccai: seven
hundred sixty.
15 The children of Binnui: six hundred
forty-eight.
16 The children of Bebai: six hundred
twenty-eight.
17 The children of Azgad: two thousand
three hundred twenty-two.
18 The children of Adonikam: six
hundred sixty-seven.
19 The children of Bigvai: two thousand
sixty-seven.
20 The children of Adin: six hundred
fifty-five.
21 The children of Ater: of Hezekiah,
ninety-eight.
22 The children of Hashum: three
hundred twenty-eight.
23 The children of Bezai: three hundred
twenty-four.
24 The children of Hariph: one hundred
twelve.
25 The children of Gibeon: ninety-five.
26 The men of Bethlehem and Netophah:
one hundred eighty-eight.
27 The men of Anathoth: one hundred
twenty-eight.
28 The men of Beth Azmaveth: forty-two.
29 The men of Kiriath Jearim,
Chephirah, and Beeroth: seven
hundred forty-three.
30 The men of Ramah and Geba: six
hundred twenty-one.
31 The men of Michmas: one hundred
twenty-two.
32 The men of Bethel and Ai: one
hundred twenty-three.
33 The men of the other Nebo: fifty-two.
34 The children of the other Elam: one
thousand two hundred fifty-four.
35 The children of Harim: three
hundred twenty.
36 The children of Jericho: three
hundred forty-five.
37 The children of Lod, Hadid, and Ono:
seven hundred twenty-one.
38 The children of Senaah: three
thousand nine hundred thirty.

39 The priests: The children of Jedaiah,
of the house of Jeshua: nine hundred
seventy-three.
40 The children of Immer: one thousand
fifty-two.
41 The children of Pashhur: one
thousand two hundred forty-seven.
42 The children of Harim: one thousand
seventeen.

43 The Levites: the children of Jeshua, of
Kadmiel, of the children of Hodevah:
seventy-four.
44 The singers: the children of Asaph:
one hundred forty-eight.
45 The gatekeepers: the children of
Shallum, the children of Ater, the
children of Talmon, the children of
Akkub, the children of Hatita, the
children of Shobai: one hundred
thirty-eight.
46 The temple servants: the children of
Ziha, the children of Hasupha, the
children of Tabbaoth,
47 the children of Keros, the children of
Sia, the children of Padon,
48 the children of Lebana, the children
of Hagaba, the children of Salmai,
49 the children of Hanan, the children of
Giddel, the children of Gahar,
50 the children of Reaiah, the children of
Rezin, the children of Nekoda,

51 the children of Gazzam, the children
of Uzza, the children of Paseah,
52 the children of Besai, the children of
Meunim, the children of Nephushesim,
53 the children of Bakbuk, the children
of Hakupha, the children of Harhur,
54 the children of Bazlith, the children of
Mehida, the children of Harsha,
55 the children of Barkos, the children of
Sisera, the children of Temah,
56 the children of Neziah, and the
children of Hatipha.
57 The children of Solomon's servants:
the children of Sotai, the children of
Sophereth, the children of Perida,
58 the children of Jaala, the children of
Darkon, the children of Giddel,
59 the children of Shephatiah, the
children of Hattil, the children of
Pochereth Hazzebaim, and the children of
Amon.
60 All the temple servants and the
children of Solomon's servants were three
hundred ninety-two.
61 These were those who went up from
Tel Melah, Tel Harsha, Cherub, Addon,
and Immer; but they could not show their
fathers' houses, nor their offspring,†
whether they were of Israel:
62 The children of Delaiah, the children
of Tobiah, the children of Nekoda: six
hundred forty-two.
63 Of the priests: the children of
Hobaiah, the children of Hakkoz, the
children of Barzillai, who took a wife
of the daughters of Barzillai the
Gileadite, and was called after their
name.
64 These searched for their genealogical
records, but couldn't find them. Therefore
they were deemed disqualified and
removed from the priesthood.
65 The governor told them not to eat of
the most holy things until a priest stood
up to minister with Urim and Thummim.
66 The whole assembly together was
forty-two thousand three hundred sixty,
67 in addition to their male servants and
their female servants, of whom there
were seven thousand three hundred
thirty-seven. They had two hundred
forty-five singing men and singing
women.
68 Their horses were seven hundred
thirty-six; their mules, two hundred
forty-five;
69 their camels, four hundred
thirty-five; their donkeys, six thousand
seven hundred twenty.
70 Some from among the heads of
fathers' households gave to the work. The
governor gave to the treasury one
thousand darics of gold,‡ fifty basins, and
five hundred thirty priests' garments.
71 Some of the heads of fathers'
households gave into the treasury of the
work twenty thousand darics of gold, and
two thousand two hundred minas§ of
silver.
72 That which the rest of the people gave
was twenty thousand darics of gold, plus
two thousand minas of silver, and
sixty-seven priests' garments.
73 So the priests, the Levites, the
gatekeepers, the singers, some of the
people, the temple servants, and all Israel
lived in their cities.
When the seventh month had come, the
children of Israel were in their cities.

8

1 All the people gathered themselves
together as one man into the wide place
that was in front of the water gate; and
they spoke to Ezra the scribe to bring the
book of the law of Moses, which Yahweh
had commanded to Israel.
2 Ezra the priest brought the law before
the assembly, both men and women, and
all who could hear with understanding,
on the first day of the seventh month.
3 He read from it before the wide place
that was in front of the water gate from
early morning until midday, in the
presence of the men and the women, and
of those who could understand. The ears
of all the people were attentive to the
book of the law.
4 Ezra the scribe stood on a pulpit of
wood, which they had made for the

† **7:61** or, seed ‡ **7:70** a daric was a gold coin issued by a Persian king, weighing about 8.4 grams or about 0.27 troy ounces each. § **7:71** A mina is about 600 grams or 1.3 U. S. pounds, so 2,200 minas is about 1.3 metric tons.

purpose; and beside him stood Mattithiah, Shema, Anaiah, Uriah, Hilkiah, and Maaseiah, on his right hand; and on his left hand, Pedaiah, Mishael, Malchijah, Hashum, Hashbaddanah, Zechariah, and Meshullam.
5 Ezra opened the book in the sight of all the people (for he was above all the people), and when he opened it, all the people stood up.
6 Then Ezra blessed Yahweh, the great God.
All the people answered, "Amen, Amen," with the lifting up of their hands. They bowed their heads, and worshiped Yahweh with their faces to the ground.
7 Also Jeshua, Bani, Sherebiah, Jamin, Akkub, Shabbethai, Hodiah, Maaseiah, Kelita, Azariah, Jozabad, Hanan, Pelaiah, and the Levites, caused the people to understand the law; and the people stayed in their place.
8 They read in the book, in the law of God, distinctly; and they gave the sense, so that they understood the reading.
9 Nehemiah, who was the governor, Ezra the priest and scribe, and the Levites who taught the people said to all the people, "Today is holy to Yahweh your God. Don't mourn, nor weep." For all the people wept when they heard the words of the law.
10 Then he said to them, "Go your way. Eat the fat, drink the sweet, and send portions to him for whom nothing is prepared, for today is holy to our Lord. Don't be grieved, for the joy of Yahweh is your strength."
11 So the Levites calmed all the people, saying, "Hold your peace, for the day is holy. Don't be grieved."
12 All the people went their way to eat, to drink, to send portions, and to celebrate, because they had understood the words that were declared to them.
13 On the second day, the heads of fathers' households of all the people, the priests, and the Levites were gathered together to Ezra the scribe, to study the words of the law.
14 They found written in the law how Yahweh had commanded by Moses that the children of Israel should dwell in booths in the feast of the seventh month;
15 and that they should publish and proclaim in all their cities and in Jerusalem, saying, "Go out to the mountain, and get olive branches, branches of wild olive, myrtle branches, palm branches, and branches of thick trees, to make temporary shelters,† as it is written."
16 So the people went out and brought them, and made themselves temporary shelters,‡ everyone on the roof of his house, in their courts, in the courts of God's house, in the wide place of the water gate, and in the wide place of Ephraim's gate.
17 All the assembly of those who had come back out of the captivity made temporary shelters§ and lived in the temporary shelters, for since the days of Joshua the son of Nun to that day the children of Israel had not done so. There was very great gladness.
18 Also day by day, from the first day to the last day, he read in the book of the law of God. They kept the feast seven days; and on the eighth day was a solemn assembly, according to the ordinance.

9

1 Now in the twenty-fourth day of this month the children of Israel were assembled with fasting, with sackcloth, and dirt on them.
2 The offspring of Israel separated themselves from all foreigners and stood and confessed their sins and the iniquities of their fathers.
3 They stood up in their place, and read in the book of the law of Yahweh their God a fourth part of the day; and a fourth part they confessed and worshiped Yahweh their God.
4 Then Jeshua, Bani, Kadmiel, Shebaniah, Bunni, Sherebiah, Bani, and Chenani of the Levites stood up on the stairs, and cried with a loud voice to Yahweh their God.

† **8:15** or, booths ‡ **8:16** or, booths § **8:17** or, booths

5 Then the Levites, Jeshua, and Kadmiel,
Bani, Hashabneiah, Sherebiah, Hodiah,
Shebaniah, and Pethahiah, said, “Stand up
and bless Yahweh your God from
everlasting to everlasting! Blessed be
your glorious name, which is exalted
above all blessing and praise!
6 You are Yahweh, even you alone. You
have made heaven, the heaven of
heavens, with all their army, the earth
and all things that are on it, the seas and
all that is in them, and you preserve them
all. The army of heaven worships you.
7 You are Yahweh, the God who chose
Abram, brought him out of Ur of the
Chaldees, gave him the name of Abraham,
8 found his heart faithful before you,
and made a covenant with him to give the
land of the Canaanite, the Hittite, the
Amorite, the Perizzite, the Jebusite, and
the Girgashite, to give it to his offspring,
and have performed your words, for you
are righteous.
9 “You saw the affliction of our fathers in
Egypt, and heard their cry by the Red Sea,
10 and showed signs and wonders
against Pharaoh, against all his servants,
and against all the people of his land, for
you knew that they dealt proudly against
them, and made a name for yourself, as it
is today.
11 You divided the sea before them, so
that they went through the middle of the
sea on the dry land; and you cast their
pursuers into the depths, as a stone into
the mighty waters.
12 Moreover, in a pillar of cloud you led
them by day; and in a pillar of fire by
night, to give them light in the way in
which they should go.
13 “You also came down on Mount Sinai,
and spoke with them from heaven, and
gave them right ordinances and true laws,
good statutes and commandments,
14 and made known to them your holy
Sabbath, and commanded them
commandments, statutes, and a law, by
Moses your servant,
15 and gave them bread from the sky for
their hunger, and brought water out of
the rock for them for their thirst, and
commanded them that they should go in
to possess the land which you had sworn
to give them.
16 “But they and our fathers behaved
proudly, hardened their neck, didn’t
listen to your commandments,
17 and refused to obey. They weren’t
mindful of your wonders that you did
among them, but hardened their neck,
and in their rebellion appointed a captain
to return to their bondage. But you are a
God ready to pardon, gracious and
merciful, slow to anger, and abundant in
loving kindness, and didn’t forsake them.
18 Yes, when they had made themselves
a molded calf, and said, ‘This is your God
who brought you up out of Egypt,’ and
had committed awful blasphemies,
19 yet you in your manifold mercies
didn’t forsake them in the wilderness. The
pillar of cloud didn’t depart from over
them by day, to lead them in the way;
neither did the pillar of fire by night, to
show them light, and the way in which
they should go.
20 You gave also your good Spirit to
instruct them, and didn’t withhold your
manna from their mouth, and gave them
water for their thirst.
21 “Yes, forty years you sustained them
in the wilderness. They lacked nothing.
Their clothes didn’t grow old, and their
feet didn’t swell.
22 Moreover you gave them kingdoms
and peoples, which you allotted according
to their portions. So they possessed the
land of Sihon, even the land of the king of
Heshbon, and the land of Og king of
Bashan.
23 You also multiplied their children as
the stars of the sky, and brought them into
the land concerning which you said to
their fathers that they should go in to
possess it.
24 “So the children went in and
possessed the land; and you subdued
before them the inhabitants of the land,
the Canaanites, and gave them into their
hands, with their kings and the peoples of
the land, that they might do with them as
they pleased.

25 They took fortified cities and a rich
land, and possessed houses full of all good
things, cisterns dug out, vineyards, olive
groves, and fruit trees in abundance. So
they ate, were filled, became fat, and
delighted themselves in your great
goodness.

26 “Nevertheless they were disobedient
and rebelled against you, cast your law
behind their back, killed your prophets
that testified against them to turn them
again to you, and they committed awful
blasphemies.

27 Therefore you delivered them into
the hand of their adversaries, who
distressed them. In the time of their
trouble, when they cried to you, you
heard from heaven; and according to
your manifold mercies you gave them
saviors who saved them out of the hands
of their adversaries.

28 But after they had rest, they did evil
again before you; therefore you left them
in the hands of their enemies, so that they
had the dominion over them; yet when
they returned and cried to you, you heard
from heaven; and many times you
delivered them according to your mercies,

29 and testified against them, that you
might bring them again to your law. Yet
they were arrogant, and didn’t listen to
your commandments, but sinned against
your ordinances (which if a man does, he
shall live in them), turned their backs,
stiffened their neck, and would not hear.

30 Yet many years you put up with them,
and testified against them by your Spirit
through your prophets. Yet they would
not listen. Therefore you gave them into
the hand of the peoples of the lands.

31 “Nevertheless in your manifold
mercies you didn’t make a full end of
them, nor forsake them; for you are a
gracious and merciful God.

32 Now therefore, our God, the great, the
mighty, and the awesome God, who keeps
covenant and loving kindness, don’t let all
the travail seem little before you that has
come on us, on our kings, on our princes,
on our priests, on our prophets, on our
fathers, and on all your people, since the
time of the kings of Assyria to this day.

33 However you are just in all that has
come on us; for you have dealt truly, but
we have done wickedly.

34 Also our kings, our princes, our
priests, and our fathers have not kept
your law, nor listened to your
commandments and your testimonies
with which you testified against them.

35 For they have not served you in their
kingdom, and in your great goodness that
you gave them, and in the large and rich
land which you gave before them. They
didn’t turn from their wicked works.

36 “Behold, we are servants today, and
as for the land that you gave to our fathers
to eat its fruit and its good, behold, we are
servants in it.

37 It yields much increase to the kings
whom you have set over us because of our
sins. Also they have power over our
bodies and over our livestock, at their
pleasure, and we are in great distress.

38 Yet for all this, we make a sure
covenant, and write it; and our princes,
our Levites, and our priests, seal it.”

10

1 Now those who sealed were:
Nehemiah the governor, the son of
Hacaliah, and Zedekiah,

2 Seraiah, Azariah, Jeremiah,

3 Pashhur, Amariah, Malchijah,

4 Hattush, Shebaniah, Malluch,

5 Harim, Meremoth, Obadiah,

6 Daniel, Ginnethon, Baruch,

7 Meshullam, Abijah, Mijamin,

8 Maaziah, Bilgai, and Shemaiah. These
were the priests.

9 The Levites: Jeshua the son of Azaniah,
Binnui of the sons of Henadad, Kadmiel;

10 and their brothers, Shebaniah,
Hodiah, Kelita, Pelaiah, Hanan,

11 Mica, Rehob, Hashabiah,

12 Zaccur, Sherebiah, Shebaniah,

13 Hodiah, Bani, and Beninu.

14 The chiefs of the people: Parosh,
Pahathmoab, Elam, Zattu, Bani,

15 Bunni, Azgad, Bebai,

16 Adonijah, Bigvai, Adin,

17 Ater, Hezekiah, Azzur,

18 Hodiah, Hashum, Bezai,
19 Hariph, Anathoth, Nobai,
20 Magpiash, Meshullam, Hezir,
21 Meshezabel, Zadok, Jaddua,
22 Pelatiah, Hanan, Anaiah,
23 Hoshea, Hananiah, Hasshub,
24 Hallohesh, Pilha, Shobek,
25 Rehum, Hashabnah, Maaseiah,
26 Ahiah, Hanan, Anan,
27 Malluch, Harim, and Baanah.

28 The rest of the people, the priests, the Levites, the gatekeepers, the singers, the temple servants, and all those who had separated themselves from the peoples of the lands to the law of God, their wives, their sons, and their daughters—everyone who had knowledge and understanding—
29 joined with their brothers, their nobles, and entered into a curse and into an oath, to walk in God's law, which was given by Moses the servant of God, and to observe and do all the commandments of Yahweh our Lord, and his ordinances and his statutes;
30 and that we would not give our daughters to the peoples of the land, nor take their daughters for our sons;
31 and if the peoples of the land bring wares or any grain on the Sabbath day to sell, that we would not buy from them on the Sabbath, or on a holy day; and that we would forego the seventh year crops and the exaction of every debt.

32 Also we made ordinances for ourselves, to charge ourselves yearly with the third part of a shekel† for the service of the house of our God:
33 for the show bread, for the continual meal offering, for the continual burnt offering, for the Sabbaths, for the new moons, for the set feasts, for the holy things, for the sin offerings to make atonement for Israel, and for all the work of the house of our God.
34 We, the priests, the Levites, and the people, cast lots for the wood offering, to bring it into the house of our God, according to our fathers' houses, at times appointed year by year, to burn on Yahweh our God's altar, as it is written in the law;
35 and to bring the first fruits of our ground and the first fruits of all fruit of all kinds of trees, year by year, to Yahweh's house;
36 also the firstborn of our sons and of our livestock, as it is written in the law, and the firstborn of our herds and of our flocks, to bring to the house of our God, to the priests who minister in the house of our God;
37 and that we should bring the first fruits of our dough, our wave offerings, the fruit of all kinds of trees, and the new wine and the oil, to the priests, to the rooms of the house of our God; and the tithes of our ground to the Levites; for they, the Levites, take the tithes in all our farming villages.
38 The priest, the descendent of Aaron, shall be with the Levites when the Levites take tithes. The Levites shall bring up the tithe of the tithes to the house of our God, to the rooms, into the treasure house.
39 For the children of Israel and the children of Levi shall bring the wave offering of the grain, of the new wine, and of the oil, to the rooms where the vessels of the sanctuary are, and the priests who minister, with the gatekeepers and the singers. We will not forsake the house of our God.

† **10:32** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

11

1 The princes of the people lived in Jerusalem. The rest of the people also cast lots to bring one of ten to dwell in Jerusalem, the holy city, and nine parts in the other cities.
2 The people blessed all the men who willingly offered themselves to dwell in Jerusalem.

3 Now these are the chiefs of the province who lived in Jerusalem; but in the cities of Judah, everyone lived in his possession in their cities—Israel, the priests, the Levites, the temple servants, and the children of Solomon's servants.
4 Some of the children of Judah and of the children of Benjamin lived in

Jerusalem. Of the children of Judah:
Athaiah the son of Uzziah, the son of
Zechariah, the son of Amariah, the son of
Shephatiah, the son of Mahalalel, of the
children of Perez;
5 and Maaseiah the son of Baruch, the
son of Colhozeh, the son of Hazaiah, the
son of Adaiah, the son of Joiarib, the son
of Zechariah, the son of the Shilonite.
6 All the sons of Perez who lived in
Jerusalem were four hundred sixty-eight
valiant men.
7 These are the sons of Benjamin: Sallu
the son of Meshullam, the son of Joed, the
son of Pedaiah, the son of Kolaiah, the son
of Maaseiah, the son of Ithiel, the son of
Jeshaiah.
8 After him Gabbai and Sallai, nine
hundred twenty-eight.
9 Joel the son of Zichri was their
overseer; and Judah the son of Hassenuah
was second over the city.
10 Of the priests: Jedaiah the son of
Joiarib, Jachin,
11 Seraiah the son of Hilkiah, the son of
Meshullam, the son of Zadok, the son of
Meraioth, the son of Ahitub, the ruler of
God's house,
12 and their brothers who did the work
of the house, eight hundred twenty-two;
and Adaiah the son of Jeroham, the son of
Pelaliah, the son of Amzi, the son of
Zechariah, the son of Pashhur, the son of
Malchijah,
13 and his brothers, chiefs of fathers'
households, two hundred forty-two; and
Amashsai the son of Azarel, the son of
Ahzai, the son of Meshillemoth, the son of
Immer,
14 and their brothers, mighty men of
valor, one hundred twenty-eight; and
their overseer was Zabdiel, the son of
Haggedolim.
15 Of the Levites: Shemaiah the son of
Hasshub, the son of Azrikam, the son of
Hashabiah, the son of Bunni;
16 and Shabbethai and Jozabad, of the
chiefs of the Levites, who had the
oversight of the outward business of
God's house;
17 and Mattaniah the son of Mica, the
son of Zabdi, the son of Asaph, who was
the chief to begin the thanksgiving in
prayer, and Bakbukiah, the second among
his brothers; and Abda the son of
Shammua, the son of Galal, the son of
Jeduthun.
18 All the Levites in the holy city were
two hundred eighty-four.
19 Moreover the gatekeepers, Akkub,
Talmon, and their brothers, who kept
watch at the gates, were one hundred
seventy-two.
20 The residue of Israel, of the priests,
and the Levites were in all the cities of
Judah, everyone in his inheritance.
21 But the temple servants lived in
Ophel; and Ziha and Gishpa were over the
temple servants.
22 The overseer also of the Levites at
Jerusalem was Uzzi the son of Bani, the
son of Hashabiah, the son of Mattaniah,
the son of Mica, of the sons of Asaph, the
singers responsible for the service of
God's house.
23 For there was a commandment from
the king concerning them, and a settled
provision for the singers, as every day
required.
24 Pethahiah the son of Meshezabel, of
the children of Zerah the son of Judah,
was at the king's hand in all matters
concerning the people.
25 As for the villages with their fields,
some of the children of Judah lived in
Kiriath Arba and its towns, in Dibon and
its towns, in Jekabzeel and its villages,
26 in Jeshua, in Moladah, Beth Pelet,
27 in Hazar Shual, in Beersheba and its
towns,
28 in Ziklag, in Meconah and in its towns,
29 in En Rimmon, in Zorah, in Jarmuth,
30 Zanoah, Adullam, and their villages,
Lachish and its fields, and Azekah and its
towns. So they encamped from Beersheba
to the valley of Hinnom.
31 The children of Benjamin also lived
from Geba onward, at Michmash and
Aija, and at Bethel and its towns,
32 at Anathoth, Nob, Ananiah,
33 Hazor, Ramah, Gittaim,
34 Hadid, Zeboim, Neballat,
35 Lod, and Ono, the valley of craftsmen.
36 Of the Levites, certain divisions in
Judah settled in Benjamin's territory.

12

1 Now these are the priests and the
Levites who went up with Zerubbabel the
son of Shealtiel, and Jeshua: Seraiah,
Jeremiah, Ezra,
2 Amariah, Malluch, Hattush,
3 Shecaniah, Rehum, Meremoth,
4 Iddo, Ginnethoi, Abijah,
5 Mijamin, Maadiah, Bilgah,
6 Shemaiah, Joiarib, Jedaiah,
7 Sallu, Amok, Hilkiah, and Jedaiah.
These were the chiefs of the priests and of
their brothers in the days of Jeshua.
8 Moreover the Levites were Jeshua,
Binnui, Kadmiel, Sherebiah, Judah, and
Mattaniah, who was over the
thanksgiving songs, he and his brothers.
9 Also Bakbukiah and Unno, their
brothers, were close to them according to
their offices.
10 Jeshua became the father of Joiakim,
and Joiakim became the father of Eliashib,
and Eliashib became the father of Joiada,
11 and Joiada became the father of
Jonathan, and Jonathan became the
father of Jaddua.
12 In the days of Joiakim were priests,
heads of fathers' households: of Seraiah,
Meraiah; of Jeremiah, Hananiah;
13 of Ezra, Meshullam; of Amariah,
Jehohanan;
14 of Malluchi, Jonathan; of Shebaniah,
Joseph;
15 of Harim, Adna; of Meraioth, Helkai;
16 of Iddo, Zechariah; of Ginnethon,
Meshullam;
17 of Abijah, Zichri; of Miniamin, of
Moadiah, Piltai;
18 of Bilgah, Shammua; of Shemaiah,
Jehonathan;
19 of Joiarib, Mattenai; of Jedaiah, Uzzi;
20 of Sallai, Kallai; of Amok, Eber;
21 of Hilkiah, Hashabiah; of Jedaiah,
Nethanel.
22 As for the Levites, in the days of
Eliashib, Joiada, Johanan, and Jaddua,
there were recorded the heads of fathers'
households; also the priests, in the reign
of Darius the Persian.
23 The sons of Levi, heads of fathers'
households, were written in the book of
the chronicles, even until the days of
Johanan the son of Eliashib.
24 The chiefs of the Levites: Hashabiah,
Sherebiah, and Jeshua the son of Kadmiel,
with their brothers close to them, to
praise and give thanks according to the
commandment of David the man of God,
section next to section.
25 Mattaniah, Bakbukiah, Obadiah,
Meshullam, Talmon, and Akkub were
gatekeepers keeping the watch at the
storehouses of the gates.
26 These were in the days of Joiakim the
son of Jeshua, the son of Jozadak, and in
the days of Nehemiah the governor, and
of Ezra the priest and scribe.
27 At the dedication of the wall of
Jerusalem, they sought the Levites out of
all their places, to bring them to
Jerusalem to keep the dedication with
gladness, both with giving thanks and
with singing, with cymbals, stringed
instruments, and with harps.
28 The sons of the singers gathered
themselves together, both out of the plain
around Jerusalem and from the villages of
the Netophathites;
29 also from Beth Gilgal and out of the
fields of Geba and Azmaveth, for the
singers had built themselves villages
around Jerusalem.
30 The priests and the Levites purified
themselves; and they purified the people,
the gates, and the wall.
31 Then I brought the princes of Judah
up on the wall, and appointed two great
companies who gave thanks and went in
procession. One went on the right hand
on the wall toward the dung gate;
32 and after them went Hoshaiah, with
half of the princes of Judah,
33 and Azariah, Ezra, and Meshullam,
34 Judah, Benjamin, Shemaiah,
Jeremiah,
35 and some of the priests' sons with
trumpets: Zechariah the son of Jonathan,
the son of Shemaiah, the son of
Mattaniah, the son of Micaiah, the son of
Zaccur, the son of Asaph;
36 and his brothers, Shemaiah, Azarel,
Milalai, Gilalai, Maai, Nethanel, Judah,

and Hanani, with the musical instruments of David the man of God; and Ezra the scribe was before them.
37 By the spring gate, and straight before them, they went up by the stairs of David's city, at the ascent of the wall, above David's house, even to the water gate eastward.
38 The other company of those who gave thanks went to meet them, and I after them, with the half of the people on the wall above the tower of the furnaces, even to the wide wall,
39 and above the gate of Ephraim, and by the old gate, and by the fish gate, the tower of Hananel, and the tower of Hammeah, even to the sheep gate; and they stood still in the gate of the guard.
40 So the two companies of those who gave thanks in God's house stood, and I and the half of the rulers with me;
41 and the priests, Eliakim, Maaseiah, Miniamin, Micaiah, Elioenai, Zechariah, and Hananiah, with trumpets;
42 and Maaseiah, Shemaiah, Eleazar, Uzzi, Jehohanan, Malchijah, Elam, and Ezer. The singers sang loud, with Jezrahiah their overseer.
43 They offered great sacrifices that day, and rejoiced, for God had made them rejoice with great joy; and the women and the children also rejoiced, so that the joy of Jerusalem was heard even far away.
44 On that day, men were appointed over the rooms for the treasures, for the wave offerings, for the first fruits, and for the tithes, to gather into them according to the fields of the cities the portions appointed by the law for the priests and Levites; for Judah rejoiced for the priests and for the Levites who served.
45 They performed the duty of their God and the duty of the purification, and so did the singers and the gatekeepers, according to the commandment of David and of Solomon his son.
46 For in the days of David and Asaph of old there was a chief of the singers, and songs of praise and thanksgiving to God.
47 All Israel in the days of Zerubbabel and in the days of Nehemiah gave the portions of the singers and the gatekeepers, as every day required; and they set apart that which was for the Levites; and the Levites set apart that which was for the sons of Aaron.

13

1 On that day they read in the book of Moses in the hearing of the people; and it was found written in it that an Ammonite and a Moabite should not enter into the assembly of God forever,
2 because they didn't meet the children of Israel with bread and with water, but hired Balaam against them to curse them; however, our God turned the curse into a blessing.
3 It came to pass, when they had heard the law, that they separated all the mixed multitude from Israel.
4 Now before this, Eliashib the priest, who was appointed over the rooms of the house of our God, being allied to Tobiah,
5 had prepared for him a great room, where before they laid the meal offerings, the frankincense, the vessels, and the tithes of the grain, the new wine, and the oil, which were given by commandment to the Levites, the singers, and the gatekeepers; and the wave offerings for the priests.
6 But in all this, I was not at Jerusalem; for in the thirty-second year of Artaxerxes king of Babylon I went to the king; and after some days I asked leave of the king,
7 and I came to Jerusalem, and understood the evil that Eliashib had done for Tobiah, in preparing him a room in the courts of God's house.
8 It grieved me severely. Therefore I threw all Tobiah's household stuff out of the room.
9 Then I commanded, and they cleansed the rooms. I brought into them the vessels of God's house, with the meal offerings and the frankincense again.
10 I perceived that the portions of the Levites had not been given them, so that the Levites and the singers, who did the work, had each fled to his field.
11 Then I contended with the rulers, and said, "Why is God's house forsaken?" I

gathered them together, and set them in their place.
12 Then all Judah brought the tithe of the grain, the new wine, and the oil to the treasuries.
13 I made treasurers over the treasuries, Shelemiah the priest, and Zadok the scribe, and of the Levites, Pedaiah: and next to them was Hanan the son of Zaccur, the son of Mattaniah; for they were counted faithful, and their business was to distribute to their brothers.
14 Remember me, my God, concerning this, and don't wipe out my good deeds that I have done for the house of my God, and for its observances.
15 In those days I saw some men treading wine presses on the Sabbath in Judah, bringing in sheaves, and loading donkeys with wine, grapes, figs, and all kinds of burdens which they brought into Jerusalem on the Sabbath day; and I testified against them in the day in which they sold food.
16 Some men of Tyre also lived there, who brought in fish and all kinds of wares, and sold on the Sabbath to the children of Judah, and in Jerusalem.
17 Then I contended with the nobles of Judah, and said to them, "What evil thing is this that you do, and profane the Sabbath day?
18 Didn't your fathers do this, and didn't our God bring all this evil on us and on this city? Yet you bring more wrath on Israel by profaning the Sabbath."
19 It came to pass that when the gates of Jerusalem began to be dark before the Sabbath, I commanded that the doors should be shut, and commanded that they should not be opened until after the Sabbath. I set some of my servants over the gates, so that no burden should be brought in on the Sabbath day.
20 So the merchants and sellers of all kinds of wares camped outside of Jerusalem once or twice.
21 Then I testified against them, and said to them, "Why do you stay around the wall? If you do so again, I will lay hands on you." From that time on, they didn't come on the Sabbath.
22 I commanded the Levites that they should purify themselves, and that they should come and keep the gates, to sanctify the Sabbath day. Remember me for this also, my God, and spare me according to the greatness of your loving kindness.
23 In those days I also saw the Jews who had married women of Ashdod, of Ammon, and of Moab;
24 and their children spoke half in the speech of Ashdod, and could not speak in the Jews' language, but according to the language of each people.
25 I contended with them, cursed them, struck certain of them, plucked off their hair, and made them swear by God, "You shall not give your daughters to their sons, nor take their daughters for your sons, or for yourselves.
26 Didn't Solomon king of Israel sin by these things? Yet among many nations there was no king like him, and he was loved by his God, and God made him king over all Israel. Nevertheless foreign women caused even him to sin.
27 Shall we then listen to you to do all this great evil, to trespass against our God in marrying foreign women?"
28 One of the sons of Joiada, the son of Eliashib the high priest, was son-in-law to Sanballat the Horonite; therefore I chased him from me.
29 Remember them, my God, because they have defiled the priesthood and the covenant of the priesthood and of the Levites.
30 Thus I cleansed them from all foreigners and appointed duties for the priests and for the Levites, everyone in his work;
31 and for the wood offering, at appointed times, and for the first fruits. Remember me, my God, for good.

The Book of Esther

1 Now in the days of Ahasuerus (this is
Ahasuerus who reigned from India even
to Ethiopia, over one hundred
twenty-seven provinces),
2 in those days, when the King
Ahasuerus sat on the throne of his
kingdom, which was in Susa the palace,
3 in the third year of his reign, he made
a feast for all his princes and his servants;
the army of Persia and Media, the nobles
and princes of the provinces being before
him.
4 He displayed the riches of his glorious
kingdom and the honor of his excellent
majesty many days, even one hundred
eighty days.

5 When these days were fulfilled, the
king made a seven day feast for all the
people who were present in Susa the
palace, both great and small, in the court
of the garden of the king's palace.
6 There were hangings of white and
blue material, fastened with cords of fine
linen and purple to silver rings and
marble pillars. The couches were of gold
and silver, on a pavement of red, white,
yellow, and black marble.
7 They gave them drinks in golden
vessels of various kinds, including royal
wine in abundance, according to the
bounty of the king.
8 In accordance with the law, the
drinking was not compulsory; for so the
king had instructed all the officials of his
house, that they should do according to
every man's pleasure.

9 Also Vashti the queen made a feast for
the women in the royal house which
belonged to King Ahasuerus.

10 On the seventh day, when the heart of
the king was merry with wine, he
commanded Mehuman, Biztha, Harbona,
Bigtha, and Abagtha, Zethar, and Carcass,
the seven eunuchs who served in the
presence of Ahasuerus the king,
11 to bring Vashti the queen before the
king wearing the royal crown, to show the
people and the princes her beauty; for she
was beautiful.
12 But the queen Vashti refused to come
at the king's commandment by the
eunuchs. Therefore the king was very
angry, and his anger burned in him.

13 Then the king said to the wise men,
who knew the times (for it was the king's
custom to consult those who knew law
and judgment;
14 and next to him were Carshena,
Shethar, Admatha, Tarshish, Meres,
Marsena, and Memucan, the seven
princes of Persia and Media, who saw the
king's face, and sat first in the kingdom),
15 "What shall we do to Queen Vashti
according to law, because she has not
done the bidding of the King Ahasuerus
by the eunuchs?"

16 Memucan answered before the king
and the princes, "Vashti the queen has not
done wrong to just the king, but also to all
the princes, and to all the people who are
in all the provinces of the King Ahasuerus.
17 For this deed of the queen will
become known to all women, causing
them to show contempt for their
husbands when it is reported, 'King
Ahasuerus commanded Vashti the queen
to be brought in before him, but she didn't
come.'
18 Today, the princesses of Persia and
Media who have heard of the queen's
deed will tell all the king's princes. This
will cause much contempt and wrath.

19 "If it pleases the king, let a royal
commandment go from him, and let it be
written among the laws of the Persians
and the Medes, so that it cannot be
altered, that Vashti may never again come
before King Ahasuerus; and let the king
give her royal estate to another who is
better than she.
20 When the king's decree which he
shall make is published throughout all his
kingdom (for it is great), all the wives will
give their husbands honor, both great and
small."

21 This advice pleased the king and the
princes, and the king did according to the
word of Memucan:
22 for he sent letters into all the king's
provinces, into every province according
to its writing, and to every people in their
language, that every man should rule his
own house, speaking in the language of
his own people.

2

1 After these things, when the wrath of
King Ahasuerus was pacified, he
remembered Vashti, and what she had
done, and what was decreed against her.
2 Then the king's servants who served
him said, "Let beautiful young virgins be
sought for the king.
3 Let the king appoint officers in all the
provinces of his kingdom, that they may
gather together all the beautiful young
virgins to the citadel of Susa, to the
women's house, to the custody of Hegai
the king's eunuch, keeper of the women.
Let cosmetics be given them;
4 and let the maiden who pleases the
king be queen instead of Vashti." The
thing pleased the king, and he did so.

5 There was a certain Jew in the citadel
of Susa whose name was Mordecai, the
son of Jair, the son of Shimei, the son of
Kish, a Benjamite,
6 who had been carried away from
Jerusalem with the captives who had been
carried away with Jeconiah king of Judah,
whom Nebuchadnezzar the king of
Babylon had carried away.
7 He brought up Hadassah, that is,
Esther, his uncle's daughter; for she had
neither father nor mother. The maiden
was fair and beautiful; and when her
father and mother were dead, Mordecai
took her for his own daughter.

8 So, when the king's commandment
and his decree was heard, and when
many maidens were gathered together to
the citadel of Susa, to the custody of Hegai,
Esther was taken into the king's house, to
the custody of Hegai, keeper of the
women.

9 The maiden pleased him, and she
obtained kindness from him. He quickly
gave her cosmetics and her portions of
food, and the seven choice maidens who
were to be given her out of the king's
house. He moved her and her maidens to
the best place in the women's house.
10 Esther had not made known her
people nor her relatives, because
Mordecai had instructed her that she
should not make it known.
11 Mordecai walked every day in front
of the court of the women's house, to find
out how Esther was doing, and what
would become of her.
12 Each young woman's turn came to go
in to King Ahasuerus after her
purification for twelve months (for so
were the days of their purification
accomplished, six months with oil of
myrrh, and six months with sweet
fragrances and with preparations for
beautifying women).
13 The young woman then came to the
king like this: whatever she desired was
given her to go with her out of the
women's house to the king's house.
14 In the evening she went, and on the
next day she returned into the second
women's house, to the custody of
Shaashgaz, the king's eunuch, who kept
the concubines. She came in to the king
no more, unless the king delighted in her,
and she was called by name.
15 Now when the turn of Esther, the
daughter of Abihail the uncle of Mordecai,
who had taken her for his daughter, came
to go in to the king, she required nothing
but what Hegai the king's eunuch, the
keeper of the women, advised. Esther
obtained favor in the sight of all those
who looked at her.
16 So Esther was taken to King
Ahasuerus into his royal house in the
tenth month, which is the month Tebeth,
in the seventh year of his reign.
17 The king loved Esther more than all
the women, and she obtained favor and
kindness in his sight more than all the
virgins; so that he set the royal crown on
her head, and made her queen instead of
Vashti.

18 Then the king made a great feast for
all his princes and his servants, even
Esther's feast; and he proclaimed a
holiday in the provinces, and gave gifts
according to the king's bounty.
19 When the virgins were gathered
together the second time, Mordecai was
sitting in the king's gate.
20 Esther had not yet made known her
relatives nor her people, as Mordecai had
commanded her; for Esther obeyed
Mordecai, like she did when she was
brought up by him.
21 In those days, while Mordecai was
sitting in the king's gate, two of the king's
eunuchs, Bigthan and Teresh, who were
doorkeepers, were angry, and sought to
lay hands on the King Ahasuerus.
22 This thing became known to
Mordecai, who informed Esther the
queen; and Esther informed the king in
Mordecai's name.
23 When this matter was investigated,
and it was found to be so, they were both
hanged on a gallows; and it was written in
the book of the chronicles in the king's
presence.

3

1 After these things King Ahasuerus
promoted Haman the son of
Hammedatha the Agagite, and advanced
him, and set his seat above all the princes
who were with him.
2 All the king's servants who were in the
king's gate bowed down and paid homage
to Haman, for the king had so commanded
concerning him. But Mordecai didn't bow
down or pay him homage.
3 Then the king's servants who were in
the king's gate said to Mordecai, "Why do
you disobey the king's commandment?"
4 Now it came to pass, when they spoke
daily to him, and he didn't listen to them,
that they told Haman, to see whether
Mordecai's reason would stand; for he
had told them that he was a Jew.
5 When Haman saw that Mordecai
didn't bow down nor pay him homage,
Haman was full of wrath.
6 But he scorned the thought of laying
hands on Mordecai alone, for they had
made known to him Mordecai's people.
Therefore Haman sought to destroy all the
Jews who were throughout the whole
kingdom of Ahasuerus, even Mordecai's
people.
7 In the first month, which is the month
Nisan, in the twelfth year of King
Ahasuerus, they cast Pur, that is, the lot,
before Haman from day to day, and from
month to month, and chose the twelfth
month, which is the month Adar.
8 Haman said to King Ahasuerus, "There
is a certain people scattered abroad and
dispersed among the peoples in all the
provinces of your kingdom, and their
laws are different from other people's.
They don't keep the king's laws. Therefore
it is not for the king's profit to allow them
to remain.
9 If it pleases the king, let it be written
that they be destroyed; and I will pay ten
thousand talents† of silver into the hands
of those who are in charge of the king's
business, to bring it into the king's
treasuries."
10 The king took his ring from his hand,
and gave it to Haman the son of
Hammedatha the Agagite, the Jews'
enemy.
11 The king said to Haman, "The silver is
given to you, the people also, to do with
them as it seems good to you."
12 Then the king's scribes were called in
on the first month, on the thirteenth day
of the month; and all that Haman
commanded was written to the king's
local governors, and to the governors who
were over every province, and to the
princes of every people, to every province
according to its writing, and to every
people in their language. It was written in
the name of King Ahasuerus, and it was
sealed with the king's ring.
13 Letters were sent by couriers into all
the king's provinces, to destroy, to kill,
and to cause to perish, all Jews, both
young and old, little children and women,
in one day, even on the thirteenth day of

† **3:9** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds or 965 Troy ounces

the twelfth month, which is the month Adar, and to plunder their possessions.
14 A copy of the letter, that the decree should be given out in every province, was published to all the peoples, that they should be ready against that day.
15 The couriers went out in haste by the king's commandment, and the decree was given out in the citadel of Susa. The king and Haman sat down to drink; but the city of Susa was perplexed.

4

1 Now when Mordecai found out all that was done, Mordecai tore his clothes and put on sackcloth with ashes, and went out into the middle of the city, and wailed loudly and bitterly.
2 He came even before the king's gate, for no one is allowed inside the king's gate clothed with sackcloth.
3 In every province, wherever the king's commandment and his decree came, there was great mourning among the Jews, and fasting, and weeping, and wailing; and many lay in sackcloth and ashes.
4 Esther's maidens and her eunuchs came and told her this, and the queen was exceedingly grieved. She sent clothing to Mordecai, to replace his sackcloth, but he didn't receive it.
5 Then Esther called for Hathach, one of the king's eunuchs, whom he had appointed to attend her, and commanded him to go to Mordecai, to find out what this was, and why it was.
6 So Hathach went out to Mordecai, to the city square which was before the king's gate.
7 Mordecai told him of all that had happened to him, and the exact sum of the money that Haman had promised to pay to the king's treasuries for the destruction of the Jews.
8 He also gave him the copy of the writing of the decree that was given out in Susa to destroy them, to show it to Esther, and to declare it to her, and to urge her to go in to the king to make supplication to him, and to make request before him for her people.
9 Hathach came and told Esther the words of Mordecai.
10 Then Esther spoke to Hathach, and gave him a message to Mordecai:
11 "All the king's servants and the people of the king's provinces know that whoever, whether man or woman, comes to the king into the inner court without being called, there is one law for him, that he be put to death, except those to whom the king might hold out the golden scepter, that he may live. I have not been called to come in to the king these thirty days."
12 They told Esther's words to Mordecai.
13 Then Mordecai asked them to return this answer to Esther: "Don't think to yourself that you will escape in the king's house any more than all the Jews.
14 For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father's house will perish. Who knows if you haven't come to the kingdom for such a time as this?"
15 Then Esther asked them to answer Mordecai,
16 "Go, gather together all the Jews who are present in Susa, and fast for me, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day. I and my maidens will also fast the same way. Then I will go in to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish."
17 So Mordecai went his way, and did according to all that Esther had commanded him.

5

1 Now on the third day, Esther put on her royal clothing and stood in the inner court of the king's house, next to the king's house. The king sat on his royal throne in the royal house, next to the entrance of the house.
2 When the king saw Esther the queen standing in the court, she obtained favor in his sight; and the king held out to Esther the golden scepter that was in his hand. So Esther came near and touched the top of the scepter.

3 Then the king asked her, “What would
you like, queen Esther? What is your
request? It shall be given you even to the
half of the kingdom.”
4 Esther said, “If it seems good to the
king, let the king and Haman come today
to the banquet that I have prepared for
him.”
5 Then the king said, “Bring Haman
quickly, so that it may be done as Esther
has said.” So the king and Haman came to
the banquet that Esther had prepared.
6 The king said to Esther at the banquet
of wine, “What is your petition? It shall be
granted you. What is your request? Even
to the half of the kingdom it shall be
performed.”
7 Then Esther answered and said, “My
petition and my request is this.
8 If I have found favor in the sight of the
king, and if it pleases the king to grant my
petition and to perform my request, let
the king and Haman come to the banquet
that I will prepare for them, and I will do
tomorrow as the king has said.”
9 Then Haman went out that day joyful
and glad of heart, but when Haman saw
Mordecai in the king’s gate, that he didn’t
stand up nor move for him, he was filled
with wrath against Mordecai.
10 Nevertheless Haman restrained
himself, and went home. There, he sent
and called for his friends and Zeresh his
wife.
11 Haman recounted to them the glory
of his riches, the multitude of his children,
all the things in which the king had
promoted him, and how he had advanced
him above the princes and servants of the
king.
12 Haman also said, “Yes, Esther the
queen let no man come in with the king to
the banquet that she had prepared but
myself; and tomorrow I am also invited by
her together with the king.
13 Yet all this avails me nothing, so long
as I see Mordecai the Jew sitting at the
king’s gate.”
14 Then Zeresh his wife and all his
friends said to him, “Let a gallows be
made fifty cubits† high, and in the
morning speak to the king about hanging
Mordecai on it. Then go in merrily with
the king to the banquet.” This pleased
Haman, so he had the gallows made.

6

1 On that night, the king couldn’t sleep.
He commanded the book of records of the
chronicles to be brought, and they were
read to the king.
2 It was found written that Mordecai
had told of Bigthana and Teresh, two of
the king’s eunuchs, who were
doorkeepers, who had tried to lay hands
on the King Ahasuerus.
3 The king said, “What honor and
dignity has been given to Mordecai for
this?”
Then the king’s servants who attended
him said, “Nothing has been done for
him.”
4 The king said, “Who is in the court?”
Now Haman had come into the outer
court of the king’s house, to speak to the
king about hanging Mordecai on the
gallows that he had prepared for him.
5 The king’s servants said to him,
“Behold,† Haman stands in the court.”
The king said, “Let him come in.”
6 So Haman came in. The king said to
him, “What shall be done to the man
whom the king delights to honor?”
Now Haman said in his heart, “Who
would the king delight to honor more
than myself?”
7 Haman said to the king, “For the man
whom the king delights to honor,
8 let royal clothing be brought which the
king uses to wear, and the horse that the
king rides on, and on the head of which a
royal crown is set.
9 Let the clothing and the horse be
delivered to the hand of one of the king’s
most noble princes, that they may array
the man whom the king delights to honor
with them, and have him ride on

† **5:14** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. † **6:5** “Behold”, from “הִנֵּה”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

horseback through the city square, and proclaim before him, 'Thus it shall be done to the man whom the king delights to honor!' "

10 Then the king said to Haman, "Hurry and take the clothing and the horse, as you have said, and do this for Mordecai the Jew, who sits at the king's gate. Let nothing fail of all that you have spoken."

11 Then Haman took the clothing and the horse, and arrayed Mordecai, and had him ride through the city square, and proclaimed before him, "Thus it shall be done to the man whom the king delights to honor!"

12 Mordecai came back to the king's gate, but Haman hurried to his house, mourning and having his head covered.

13 Haman recounted to Zeresh his wife and all his friends everything that had happened to him. Then his wise men and Zeresh his wife said to him, "If Mordecai, before whom you have begun to fall, is of Jewish descent, you will not prevail against him, but you will surely fall before him."

14 While they were yet talking with him, the king's eunuchs came, and hurried to bring Haman to the banquet that Esther had prepared.

7

1 So the king and Haman came to banquet with Esther the queen.

2 The king said again to Esther on the second day at the banquet of wine, "What is your petition, queen Esther? It shall be granted you. What is your request? Even to the half of the kingdom it shall be performed."

3 Then Esther the queen answered, "If I have found favor in your sight, O king, and if it pleases the king, let my life be given me at my petition, and my people at my request.

4 For we are sold, I and my people, to be destroyed, to be slain, and to perish. But if we had been sold for male and female slaves, I would have held my peace, although the adversary could not have compensated for the king's loss."

5 Then King Ahasuerus said to Esther the queen, "Who is he, and where is he who dared presume in his heart to do so?"

6 Esther said, "An adversary and an enemy, even this wicked Haman!"

Then Haman was afraid before the king and the queen.

7 The king arose in his wrath from the banquet of wine and went into the palace garden. Haman stood up to make request for his life to Esther the queen, for he saw that there was evil determined against him by the king.

8 Then the king returned out of the palace garden into the place of the banquet of wine; and Haman had fallen on the couch where Esther was. Then the king said, "Will he even assault the queen in front of me in the house?" As the word went out of the king's mouth, they covered Haman's face.

9 Then Harbonah, one of the eunuchs who were with the king, said, "Behold, the gallows fifty cubits† high, which Haman has made for Mordecai, who spoke good for the king, is standing at Haman's house."

The king said, "Hang him on it!"

10 So they hanged Haman on the gallows that he had prepared for Mordecai. Then the king's wrath was pacified.

8

1 On that day, King Ahasuerus gave the house of Haman, the Jews' enemy, to Esther the queen. Mordecai came before the king; for Esther had told what he was to her.

2 The king took off his ring, which he had taken from Haman, and gave it to Mordecai. Esther set Mordecai over the house of Haman.

3 Esther spoke yet again before the king, and fell down at his feet and begged him with tears to put away the mischief of Haman the Agagite, and his plan that he had planned against the Jews.

† **7:9** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

4 Then the king held out to Esther the
golden scepter. So Esther arose, and stood
before the king.
5 She said, “If it pleases the king, and if I
have found favor in his sight, and the
thing seems right to the king, and I am
pleasing in his eyes, let it be written to
reverse the letters devised by Haman, the
son of Hammedatha the Agagite, which he
wrote to destroy the Jews who are in all
the king’s provinces.
6 For how can I endure to see the evil
that would come to my people? How can I
endure to see the destruction of my
relatives?”

7 Then King Ahasuerus said to Esther
the queen and to Mordecai the Jew, “See, I
have given Esther the house of Haman,
and they have hanged him on the gallows
because he laid his hand on the Jews.
8 Write also to the Jews as it pleases you,
in the king’s name, and seal it with the
king’s ring; for the writing which is
written in the king’s name, and sealed
with the king’s ring, may not be reversed
by any man.”

9 Then the king’s scribes were called at
that time, in the third month, which is the
month Sivan, on the twenty-third day of
the month; and it was written according
to all that Mordecai commanded to the
Jews, and to the local governors, and the
governors and princes of the provinces
which are from India to Ethiopia, one
hundred twenty-seven provinces, to
every province according to its writing,
and to every people in their language, and
to the Jews in their writing, and in their
language.
10 He wrote in the name of King
Ahasuerus, and sealed it with the king’s
ring, and sent letters by courier on
horseback, riding on royal horses that
were bred from swift steeds.
11 In those letters, the king granted the
Jews who were in every city to gather
themselves together and to defend their
lives—to destroy, to kill, and to cause to
perish all the power of the people and
province that would assault them, their
little ones and women, and to plunder
their possessions,
12 on one day in all the provinces of King
Ahasuerus, on the thirteenth day of the
twelfth month, which is the month Adar.
13 A copy of the letter, that the decree
should be given out in every province,
was published to all the peoples, that the
Jews should be ready for that day to
avenge themselves on their enemies.
14 So the couriers who rode on royal
horses went out, hastened and pressed on
by the king’s commandment. The decree
was given out in the citadel of Susa.

15 Mordecai went out of the presence of
the king in royal clothing of blue and
white, and with a great crown of gold, and
with a robe of fine linen and purple; and
the city of Susa shouted and was glad.
16 The Jews had light, gladness, joy, and
honor.
17 In every province and in every city,
wherever the king’s commandment and
his decree came, the Jews had gladness,
joy, a feast and a holiday. Many from
among the peoples of the land became
Jews, for the fear of the Jews had fallen on
them.

9

1 Now in the twelfth month, which is the
month Adar, on the thirteenth day of the
month, when the king’s commandment
and his decree came near to be put in
execution, on the day that the enemies of
the Jews hoped to conquer them, (but it
turned out that the opposite happened,
that the Jews conquered those who hated
them),
2 the Jews gathered themselves together
in their cities throughout all the provinces
of the King Ahasuerus, to lay hands on
those who wanted to harm them. No one
could withstand them, because the fear of
them had fallen on all the people.
3 All the princes of the provinces, the
local governors, the governors, and those
who did the king’s business helped the
Jews, because the fear of Mordecai had
fallen on them.

4 For Mordecai was great in the king's
house, and his fame went out throughout
all the provinces, for the man Mordecai
grew greater and greater.
5 The Jews struck all their enemies with
the stroke of the sword, and with
slaughter and destruction, and did what
they wanted to those who hated them.
6 In the citadel of Susa, the Jews killed
and destroyed five hundred men.
7 They killed Parshandatha, Dalphon,
Aspatha,
8 Poratha, Adalia, Aridatha,
9 Parmashta, Arisai, Aridai, and
Vaizatha,
10 the ten sons of Haman the son of
Hammedatha, the Jews' enemy, but they
didn't lay their hand on the plunder.

11 On that day, the number of those who
were slain in the citadel of Susa was
brought before the king.
12 The king said to Esther the queen,
"The Jews have slain and destroyed five
hundred men in the citadel of Susa,
including the ten sons of Haman; what
then have they done in the rest of the
king's provinces! Now what is your
petition? It shall be granted you. What is
your further request? It shall be done."

13 Then Esther said, "If it pleases the
king, let it be granted to the Jews who are
in Susa to do tomorrow also according to
today's decree, and let Haman's ten sons
be hanged on the gallows."

14 The king commanded this to be done.
A decree was given out in Susa; and they
hanged Haman's ten sons.
15 The Jews who were in Susa gathered
themselves together on the fourteenth
day also of the month Adar, and killed
three hundred men in Susa; but they
didn't lay their hand on the plunder.

16 The other Jews who were in the king's
provinces gathered themselves together,
defended their lives, had rest from their
enemies, and killed seventy-five thousand
of those who hated them; but they didn't
lay their hand on the plunder.

17 This was done on the thirteenth day
of the month Adar; and on the fourteenth
day of that month they rested and made it
a day of feasting and gladness.

18 But the Jews who were in Susa
assembled together on the thirteenth and
on the fourteenth days of the month; and
on the fifteenth day of that month, they
rested, and made it a day of feasting and
gladness.
19 Therefore the Jews of the villages,
who live in the unwalled towns, make the
fourteenth day of the month Adar a day of
gladness and feasting, a holiday, and a
day of sending presents of food to one
another.
20 Mordecai wrote these things, and sent
letters to all the Jews who were in all the
provinces of the King Ahasuerus, both
near and far,
21 to enjoin them that they should keep
the fourteenth and fifteenth days of the
month Adar yearly,
22 as the days in which the Jews had rest
from their enemies, and the month which
was turned to them from sorrow to
gladness, and from mourning into a
holiday; that they should make them days
of feasting and gladness, and of sending
presents of food to one another, and gifts
to the needy.
23 The Jews accepted the custom that
they had begun, as Mordecai had written
to them,
24 because Haman the son of
Hammedatha, the Agagite, the enemy of
all the Jews, had plotted against the Jews
to destroy them, and had cast "Pur", that is
the lot, to consume them and to destroy
them;
25 but when this became known to the
king, he commanded by letters that his
wicked plan, which he had planned
against the Jews, should return on his
own head, and that he and his sons should
be hanged on the gallows.
26 Therefore they called these days
"Purim",† from the word "Pur." Therefore
because of all the words of this letter, and
of that which they had seen concerning

† **9:26** Purim is the Hebrew plural for pur, which means lot.

this matter, and that which had come to them,
27 the Jews established and imposed on themselves, on their descendants, and on all those who joined themselves to them, so that it should not fail that they would keep these two days according to what was written and according to its appointed time every year;
28 and that these days should be remembered and kept throughout every generation, every family, every province, and every city; and that these days of Purim should not fail from among the Jews, nor their memory perish from their offspring.‡
29 Then Esther the queen, the daughter of Abihail, and Mordecai the Jew wrote with all authority to confirm this second letter of Purim.
30 He sent letters to all the Jews in the hundred twenty-seven provinces of the kingdom of Ahasuerus with words of peace and truth,
31 to confirm these days of Purim in their appointed times, as Mordecai the Jew and Esther the queen had decreed, and as they had imposed upon themselves and their descendants in the matter of the fastings and their mourning.
32 The commandment of Esther confirmed these matters of Purim; and it was written in the book.

10

1 King Ahasuerus laid a tribute on the land and on the islands of the sea.
2 Aren't all the acts of his power and of his might, and the full account of the greatness of Mordecai, to which the king advanced him, written in the book of the chronicles of the kings of Media and Persia?
3 For Mordecai the Jew was next to King Ahasuerus, and great among the Jews and accepted by the multitude of his brothers, seeking the good of his people and speaking peace to all his descendants.

‡ **9:28** or, seed

The Book of Job

1 There was a man in the land of Uz,
whose name was Job. That man was
blameless and upright, and one who
feared God,† and turned away from evil.
2 There were born to him seven sons
and three daughters.
3 His possessions also were seven
thousand sheep, three thousand camels,
five hundred yoke of oxen, five hundred
female donkeys, and a very great
household; so that this man was the
greatest of all the children of the east.
4 His sons went and held a feast in the
house of each one on his birthday; and
they sent and called for their three sisters
to eat and to drink with them.
5 It was so, when the days of their
feasting had run their course, that Job
sent and sanctified them, and rose up
early in the morning, and offered burnt
offerings according to the number of
them all. For Job said, "It may be that my
sons have sinned, and renounced God in
their hearts." Job did so continually.
6 Now on the day when God's sons came
to present themselves before Yahweh,‡
Satan also came among them.
7 Yahweh said to Satan, "Where have
you come from?"

Then Satan answered Yahweh, and said,
"From going back and forth in the earth,
and from walking up and down in it."
8 Yahweh said to Satan, "Have you
considered my servant, Job? For there is
no one like him in the earth, a blameless
and an upright man, one who fears God,
and turns away from evil."
9 Then Satan answered Yahweh, and
said, "Does Job fear God for nothing?
10 Haven't you made a hedge around
him, and around his house, and around
all that he has, on every side? You have
blessed the work of his hands, and his
substance is increased in the land.
11 But stretch out your hand now, and
touch all that he has, and he will renounce
you to your face."
12 Yahweh said to Satan, "Behold,§ all
that he has is in your power. Only on
himself don't stretch out your hand."

So Satan went out from the presence of
Yahweh.
13 It fell on a day when his sons and his
daughters were eating and drinking wine
in their oldest brother's house,
14 that a messenger came to Job, and
said, "The oxen were plowing, and the
donkeys feeding beside them,
15 and the Sabeans attacked, and took
them away. Yes, they have killed the
servants with the edge of the sword, and I
alone have escaped to tell you."
16 While he was still speaking, another
also came and said, "The fire of God has
fallen from the sky, and has burned up
the sheep and the servants, and
consumed them, and I alone have escaped
to tell you."
17 While he was still speaking, another
also came and said, "The Chaldeans made
three bands, and swept down on the
camels, and have taken them away, yes,
and killed the servants with the edge of
the sword; and I alone have escaped to tell
you."
18 While he was still speaking, there
came also another, and said, "Your sons
and your daughters were eating and
drinking wine in their oldest brother's
house,
19 and behold, there came a great wind
from the wilderness, and struck the four
corners of the house, and it fell on the
young men, and they are dead. I alone
have escaped to tell you."
20 Then Job arose, and tore his robe, and
shaved his head, and fell down on the
ground, and worshiped.
21 He said, "Naked I came out of my
mother's womb, and naked will I return

† **1:1** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). ‡ **1:6** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. § **1:12** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

there. Yahweh gave, and Yahweh has
taken away. Blessed be Yahweh's name."
22 In all this, Job didn't sin, nor charge
God with wrongdoing.

2

1 Again, on the day when God's sons
came to present themselves before
Yahweh, Satan came also among them to
present himself before Yahweh.
2 Yahweh said to Satan, "Where have
you come from?"
Satan answered Yahweh, and said,
"From going back and forth in the earth,
and from walking up and down in it."
3 Yahweh said to Satan, "Have you
considered my servant Job? For there is
no one like him in the earth, a blameless
and an upright man, one who fears God,
and turns away from evil. He still
maintains his integrity, although you
incited me against him, to ruin him
without cause."
4 Satan answered Yahweh, and said,
"Skin for skin. Yes, all that a man has he
will give for his life.
5 But stretch out your hand now, and
touch his bone and his flesh, and he will
renounce you to your face."
6 Yahweh said to Satan, "Behold, he is in
your hand. Only spare his life."
7 So Satan went out from the presence
of Yahweh, and struck Job with painful
sores from the sole of his foot to his head.
8 He took for himself a potsherd to
scrape himself with, and he sat among the
ashes.
9 Then his wife said to him, "Do you still
maintain your integrity? Renounce God,
and die."
10 But he said to her, "You speak as one
of the foolish women would speak. What?
Shall we receive good at the hand of God,
and shall we not receive evil?"
In all this Job didn't sin with his lips.
11 Now when Job's three friends heard
of all this evil that had come on him, they
each came from his own place: Eliphaz
the Temanite, Bildad the Shuhite, and
Zophar the Naamathite; and they made
an appointment together to come to
sympathize with him and to comfort him.
12 When they lifted up their eyes from a
distance, and didn't recognize him, they
raised their voices, and wept; and they
each tore his robe, and sprinkled dust on
their heads toward the sky.
13 So they sat down with him on the
ground seven days and seven nights, and
no one spoke a word to him, for they saw
that his grief was very great.

3

1 After this Job opened his mouth, and
cursed the day of his birth.
2 Job answered:
3 "Let the day perish in which I was born,
the night which said, 'There is a boy
conceived.'
4 Let that day be darkness.
Don't let God from above seek for it,
neither let the light shine on it.
5 Let darkness and the shadow of death
claim it for their own.
Let a cloud dwell on it.
Let all that makes the day black
terrify it.
6 As for that night, let thick darkness seize
on it.
Let it not rejoice among the days of
the year.
Let it not come into the number of the
months.
7 Behold, let that night be barren.
Let no joyful voice come therein.
8 Let them curse it who curse the day,
who are ready to rouse up leviathan.
9 Let the stars of its twilight be dark.
Let it look for light, but have none,
neither let it see the eyelids of the
morning,
10 because it didn't shut up the doors of
my mother's womb,
nor did it hide trouble from my eyes.

11 "Why didn't I die from the womb?
Why didn't I give up the spirit when
my mother bore me?
12 Why did the knees receive me?
Or why the breast, that I should
nurse?
13 For now I should have lain down and
been quiet.

I should have slept, then I would have
been at rest,
14 with kings and counselors of the earth,
who built up waste places for
themselves;
15 or with princes who had gold,
who filled their houses with silver;
16 or as a hidden untimely birth I had not
been,
as infants who never saw light.
17 There the wicked cease from troubling.
There the weary are at rest.
18 There the prisoners are at ease together.
They don't hear the voice of the
taskmaster.
19 The small and the great are there.
The servant is free from his master.

20 "Why is light given to him who is in
misery,
life to the bitter in soul,
21 who long for death, but it doesn't come;
and dig for it more than for hidden
treasures,
22 who rejoice exceedingly,
and are glad, when they can find the
grave?
23 Why is light given to a man whose way
is hidden,
whom God has hedged in?
24 For my sighing comes before I eat.
My groanings are poured out like
water.
25 For the thing which I fear comes on me,
that which I am afraid of comes to me.
26 I am not at ease, neither am I quiet,
neither do I have rest;
but trouble comes."

4

1 Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered,
2 "If someone ventures to talk with you,
will you be grieved?
But who can withhold himself from
speaking?
3 Behold, you have instructed many,
you have strengthened the weak
hands.
4 Your words have supported him who
was falling,
you have made the feeble knees firm.
5 But now it has come to you, and you
faint.
It touches you, and you are troubled.
6 Isn't your piety your confidence?
Isn't the integrity of your ways your
hope?

7 "Remember, now, who ever perished,
being innocent?
Or where were the upright cut off?
8 According to what I have seen, those
who plow iniquity
and sow trouble, reap the same.
9 By the breath of God they perish.
By the blast of his anger are they
consumed.
10 The roaring of the lion,
and the voice of the fierce lion,
the teeth of the young lions, are
broken.
11 The old lion perishes for lack of prey.
The cubs of the lioness are scattered
abroad.

12 "Now a thing was secretly brought to
me.
My ear received a whisper of it.
13 In thoughts from the visions of the
night,
when deep sleep falls on men,
14 fear came on me, and trembling,
which made all my bones shake.
15 Then a spirit passed before my face.
The hair of my flesh stood up.
16 It stood still, but I couldn't discern its
appearance.
A form was before my eyes.
Silence, then I heard a voice, saying,
17 'Shall mortal man be more just than
God?
Shall a man be more pure than his
Maker?
18 Behold, he puts no trust in his servants.
He charges his angels with error.
19 How much more those who dwell in
houses of clay,
whose foundation is in the dust,
who are crushed before the moth!
20 Between morning and evening they are
destroyed.
They perish forever without any
regarding it.
21 Isn't their tent cord plucked up within
them?
They die, and that without wisdom.'

5

1 “Call now; is there any who will answer you?
To which of the holy ones will you turn?
2 For resentment kills the foolish man,
and jealousy kills the simple.
3 I have seen the foolish taking root,
but suddenly I cursed his habitation.
4 His children are far from safety.
They are crushed in the gate.
Neither is there any to deliver them,
5 whose harvest the hungry eat up,
and take it even out of the thorns.
The snare gapes for their substance.
6 For affliction doesn’t come out of the dust,
neither does trouble spring out of the ground;
7 but man is born to trouble,
as the sparks fly upward.

8 “But as for me, I would seek God.
I would commit my cause to God,
9 who does great things that can’t be fathomed,
marvelous things without number;
10 who gives rain on the earth,
and sends waters on the fields;
11 so that he sets up on high those who are low,
those who mourn are exalted to safety.
12 He frustrates the plans of the crafty,
so that their hands can’t perform their enterprise.
13 He takes the wise in their own craftiness;
the counsel of the cunning is carried headlong.
14 They meet with darkness in the day time,
and grope at noonday as in the night.
15 But he saves from the sword of their mouth,
even the needy from the hand of the mighty.
16 So the poor has hope,
and injustice shuts her mouth.
17 “Behold, happy is the man whom God corrects.
Therefore do not despise the chastening of the Almighty.
18 For he wounds and binds up.
He injures and his hands make whole.
19 He will deliver you in six troubles;
yes, in seven no evil will touch you.
20 In famine he will redeem you from death;
in war, from the power of the sword.
21 You will be hidden from the scourge of the tongue,
neither will you be afraid of destruction when it comes.
22 You will laugh at destruction and famine,
neither will you be afraid of the animals of the earth.
23 For you will be allied with the stones of the field.
The animals of the field will be at peace with you.
24 You will know that your tent is in peace.
You will visit your fold, and will miss nothing.
25 You will know also that your offspring† will be great,
your offspring as the grass of the earth.
26 You will come to your grave in a full age,
like a shock of grain comes in its season.
27 Behold, we have researched it. It is so.
Hear it, and know it for your good.”

6

1 Then Job answered,
2 “Oh that my anguish were weighed,
and all my calamity laid in the balances!
3 For now it would be heavier than the sand of the seas,
therefore my words have been rash.
4 For the arrows of the Almighty are within me.
My spirit drinks up their poison.
The terrors of God set themselves in array against me.
5 Does the wild donkey bray when he has grass?

† **5:25** or, seed

Or does the ox low over his fodder?
6 Can that which has no flavor be
eaten without salt?
Or is there any taste in the white of an
egg?
7 My soul refuses to touch them.
They are as loathsome food to me.

8 "Oh that I might have my request,
that God would grant the thing that I
long for,
9 even that it would please God to crush
me;
that he would let loose his hand, and
cut me off!
10 Let it still be my consolation,
yes, let me exult in pain that doesn't
spare,
that I have not denied the words of
the Holy One.
11 What is my strength, that I should wait?
What is my end, that I should be
patient?
12 Is my strength the strength of stones?
Or is my flesh of bronze?
13 Isn't it that I have no help in me,
that wisdom is driven away from me?

14 "To him who is ready to faint, kindness
should be shown from his friend;
even to him who forsakes the fear of
the Almighty.
15 My brothers have dealt deceitfully as a
brook,
as the channel of brooks that pass
away;
16 which are black by reason of the ice,
in which the snow hides itself.
17 In the dry season, they vanish.
When it is hot, they are consumed out
of their place.
18 The caravans that travel beside them
turn away.
They go up into the waste, and perish.
19 The caravans of Tema looked.
The companies of Sheba waited for
them.
20 They were distressed because they
were confident.
They came there, and were
confounded.
21 For now you are nothing.
You see a terror, and are afraid.
22 Did I ever say, 'Give to me'?
or, 'Offer a present for me from your
substance'?
23 or, 'Deliver me from the adversary's
hand'?
or, 'Redeem me from the hand of the
oppressors'?

24 "Teach me, and I will hold my peace.
Cause me to understand my error.
25 How forcible are words of uprightness!
But your reproof, what does it
reprove?
26 Do you intend to reprove words,
since the speeches of one who is
desperate are as wind?
27 Yes, you would even cast lots for the
fatherless,
and make merchandise of your
friend.
28 Now therefore be pleased to look at me,
for surely I will not lie to your face.
29 Please return.
Let there be no injustice.
Yes, return again.
My cause is righteous.
30 Is there injustice on my tongue?
Can't my taste discern mischievous
things?

7

1 "Isn't a man forced to labor on earth?
Aren't his days like the days of a hired
hand?
2 As a servant who earnestly desires the
shadow,
as a hireling who looks for his wages,
3 so I am made to possess months of
misery,
wearisome nights are appointed to
me.
4 When I lie down, I say,
'When will I arise, and the night be
gone?'
I toss and turn until the dawning of
the day.
5 My flesh is clothed with worms and clods
of dust.
My skin closes up, and breaks out
afresh.
6 My days are swifter than a weaver's
shuttle,

and are spent without hope.
7 Oh remember that my life is a breath.
My eye will no more see good.
8 The eye of him who sees me will see me no more.
Your eyes will be on me, but I will not be.
9 As the cloud is consumed and vanishes away,
so he who goes down to Sheol† will come up no more.
10 He will return no more to his house,
neither will his place know him any more.

11 "Therefore I will not keep silent.
I will speak in the anguish of my spirit.
I will complain in the bitterness of my soul.
12 Am I a sea, or a sea monster,
that you put a guard over me?
13 When I say, 'My bed will comfort me.
My couch will ease my complaint,'
14 then you scare me with dreams
and terrify me through visions,
15 so that my soul chooses strangling,
death rather than my bones.
16 I loathe my life.
I don't want to live forever.
Leave me alone, for my days are but a breath.
17 What is man, that you should magnify him,
that you should set your mind on him,
18 that you should visit him every morning,
and test him every moment?
19 How long will you not look away from me,
nor leave me alone until I swallow down my spittle?
20 If I have sinned, what do I do to you, you watcher of men?
Why have you set me as a mark for you,
so that I am a burden to myself?
21 Why do you not pardon my disobedience, and take away my iniquity?
For now will I lie down in the dust.
You will seek me diligently, but I will not be."

† **7:9** Sheol is the place of the dead.

8

1 Then Bildad the Shuhite answered,
2 "How long will you speak these things?
Shall the words of your mouth be a mighty wind?
3 Does God pervert justice?
Or does the Almighty pervert righteousness?
4 If your children have sinned against him,
he has delivered them into the hand of their disobedience.
5 If you want to seek God diligently,
make your supplication to the Almighty.
6 If you were pure and upright,
surely now he would awaken for you,
and make the habitation of your righteousness prosperous.
7 Though your beginning was small,
yet your latter end would greatly increase.

8 "Please inquire of past generations.
Find out about the learning of their fathers.
9 (For we are but of yesterday, and know nothing,
because our days on earth are a shadow.)
10 Shall they not teach you, tell you,
and utter words out of their heart?

11 "Can the papyrus grow up without mire?
Can the rushes grow without water?
12 While it is yet in its greenness, not cut down,
it withers before any other reed.
13 So are the paths of all who forget God.
The hope of the godless man will perish,
14 whose confidence will break apart,
whose trust is a spider's web.
15 He will lean on his house, but it will not stand.
He will cling to it, but it will not endure.
16 He is green before the sun.
His shoots go out along his garden.

17 His roots are wrapped around the rock pile.
He sees the place of stones.
18 If he is destroyed from his place,
then it will deny him, saying, 'I have not seen you.'
19 Behold, this is the joy of his way.
Out of the earth, others will spring.

20 "Behold, God will not cast away a blameless man,
neither will he uphold the evildoers.
21 He will still fill your mouth with laughter,
your lips with shouting.
22 Those who hate you will be clothed with shame.
The tent of the wicked will be no more."

9

1 Then Job answered,
2 "Truly I know that it is so,
but how can man be just with God?
3 If he is pleased to contend with him,
he can't answer him one time in a thousand.
4 God is wise in heart, and mighty in strength.
Who has hardened himself against him and prospered?
5 He removes the mountains, and they don't know it,
when he overturns them in his anger.
6 He shakes the earth out of its place.
Its pillars tremble.
7 He commands the sun and it doesn't rise,
and seals up the stars.
8 He alone stretches out the heavens,
and treads on the waves of the sea.
9 He makes the Bear, Orion, and the Pleiades,
and the rooms of the south.
10 He does great things past finding out;
yes, marvelous things without number.
11 Behold, he goes by me, and I don't see him.
He passes on also, but I don't perceive him.
12 Behold, he snatches away.
Who can hinder him?
Who will ask him, 'What are you doing?'

13 "God will not withdraw his anger.
The helpers of Rahab stoop under him.
14 How much less will I answer him,
and choose my words to argue with him?
15 Though I were righteous, yet I wouldn't answer him.
I would make supplication to my judge.
16 If I had called, and he had answered me,
yet I wouldn't believe that he listened to my voice.
17 For he breaks me with a storm,
and multiplies my wounds without cause.
18 He will not allow me to catch my breath,
but fills me with bitterness.
19 If it is a matter of strength, behold, he is mighty!
If of justice, 'Who,' says he, 'will summon me?'
20 Though I am righteous, my own mouth will condemn me.
Though I am blameless, it will prove me perverse.
21 I am blameless.
I don't respect myself.
I despise my life.

22 "It is all the same.
Therefore I say he destroys the blameless and the wicked.
23 If the scourge kills suddenly,
he will mock at the trial of the innocent.
24 The earth is given into the hand of the wicked.
He covers the faces of its judges.
If not he, then who is it?

25 "Now my days are swifter than a runner.
They flee away. They see no good.
26 They have passed away as the swift ships,
as the eagle that swoops on the prey.
27 If I say, 'I will forget my complaint,
I will put off my sad face, and cheer up,'
28 I am afraid of all my sorrows.

I know that you will not hold me
innocent.
29 I will be condemned.
Why then do I labor in vain?
30 If I wash myself with snow,
and cleanse my hands with lye,
31 yet you will plunge me in the ditch.
My own clothes will abhor me.
32 For he is not a man, as I am, that I
should answer him,
that we should come together in
judgment.
33 There is no umpire between us,
that might lay his hand on us both.
34 Let him take his rod away from me.
Let his terror not make me afraid;
35 then I would speak, and not fear him,
for I am not so in myself.

10

1 "My soul is weary of my life.
I will give free course to my
complaint.
I will speak in the bitterness of my
soul.
2 I will tell God, 'Do not condemn me.
Show me why you contend with me.
3 Is it good to you that you should oppress,
that you should despise the work of
your hands,
and smile on the counsel of the
wicked?
4 Do you have eyes of flesh?
Or do you see as man sees?
5 Are your days as the days of mortals,
or your years as man's years,
6 that you inquire after my iniquity,
and search after my sin?
7 Although you know that I am not wicked,
there is no one who can deliver out of
your hand.

8 " 'Your hands have framed me and
fashioned me altogether,
yet you destroy me.
9 Remember, I beg you, that you have
fashioned me as clay.
Will you bring me into dust again?
10 Haven't you poured me out like milk,
and curdled me like cheese?
11 You have clothed me with skin and
flesh,
and knit me together with bones and
sinews.
12 You have granted me life and loving
kindness.
Your visitation has preserved my
spirit.
13 Yet you hid these things in your heart.
I know that this is with you:
14 if I sin, then you mark me.
You will not acquit me from my
iniquity.
15 If I am wicked, woe to me.
If I am righteous, I still will not lift up
my head,
being filled with disgrace,
and conscious of my affliction.
16 If my head is held high, you hunt me
like a lion.
Again you show yourself powerful to
me.
17 You renew your witnesses against me,
and increase your indignation on me.
Changes and warfare are with me.

18 " 'Why, then, have you brought me out
of the womb?
I wish I had given up the spirit, and
no eye had seen me.
19 I should have been as though I had not
been.
I should have been carried from the
womb to the grave.
20 Aren't my days few?
Stop!
Leave me alone, that I may find a little
comfort,
21 before I go where I will not return
from,
to the land of darkness and of the
shadow of death;
22 the land dark as midnight,
of the shadow of death,
without any order,
where the light is as midnight.' "

11

1 Then Zophar, the Naamathite,
answered,
2 "Shouldn't the multitude of words be
answered?
Should a man full of talk be justified?

3 Should your boastings make men hold
their peace?
When you mock, will no man make
you ashamed?
4 For you say, ‘My doctrine is pure.
I am clean in your eyes.’
5 But oh that God would speak,
and open his lips against you,
6 that he would show you the secrets of
wisdom!
For true wisdom has two sides.
Know therefore that God exacts of
you less than your iniquity
deserves.

7 “Can you fathom the mystery of God?
Or can you probe the limits of the
Almighty?
8 They are high as heaven. What can you
do?
They are deeper than Sheol.† What
can you know?
9 Its measure is longer than the earth,
and broader than the sea.
10 If he passes by, or confines,
or convenes a court, then who can
oppose him?
11 For he knows false men.
He sees iniquity also, even though he
doesn’t consider it.
12 An empty-headed man becomes wise
when a man is born as a wild
donkey’s colt.

13 “If you set your heart aright,
stretch out your hands toward him.
14 If iniquity is in your hand, put it far
away.
Don’t let unrighteousness dwell in
your tents.
15 Surely then you will lift up your face
without spot.
Yes, you will be steadfast, and will not
fear,
16 for you will forget your misery.
You will remember it like waters that
have passed away.
17 Life will be clearer than the noonday.
Though there is darkness, it will be as
the morning.
18 You will be secure, because there is
hope.
Yes, you will search, and will take
your rest in safety.
19 Also you will lie down, and no one will
make you afraid.
Yes, many will court your favor.
20 But the eyes of the wicked will fail.
They will have no way to flee.
Their hope will be the giving up of the
spirit.”

12

1 Then Job answered,
2 “No doubt, but you are the people,
and wisdom will die with you.
3 But I have understanding as well as you;
I am not inferior to you.
Yes, who doesn’t know such things as
these?
4 I am like one who is a joke to his
neighbor,
I, who called on God, and he
answered.
The just, the blameless man is a joke.
5 In the thought of him who is at ease
there is contempt for misfortune.
It is ready for them whose foot slips.
6 The tents of robbers prosper.
Those who provoke God are secure,
who carry their god in their hands.

7 “But ask the animals now, and they will
teach you;
the birds of the sky, and they will tell
you.
8 Or speak to the earth, and it will teach
you.
The fish of the sea will declare to you.
9 Who doesn’t know that in all these,
Yahweh’s hand has done this,
10 in whose hand is the life of every living
thing,
and the breath of all mankind?
11 Doesn’t the ear try words,
even as the palate tastes its food?
12 With aged men is wisdom,
in length of days understanding.

13 “With God is wisdom and might.
He has counsel and understanding.
14 Behold, he breaks down, and it can’t be
built again.

† **11:8** Sheol is the place of the dead.

He imprisons a man, and there can be no release.
15 Behold, he withholds the waters, and they dry up.
Again, he sends them out, and they overturn the earth.
16 With him is strength and wisdom.
The deceived and the deceiver are his.
17 He leads counselors away stripped.
He makes judges fools.
18 He loosens the bond of kings.
He binds their waist with a belt.
19 He leads priests away stripped,
and overthrows the mighty.
20 He removes the speech of those who are trusted,
and takes away the understanding of the elders.
21 He pours contempt on princes,
and loosens the belt of the strong.
22 He uncovers deep things out of darkness,
and brings out to light the shadow of death.
23 He increases the nations, and he destroys them.
He enlarges the nations, and he leads them captive.
24 He takes away understanding from the chiefs of the people of the earth,
and causes them to wander in a wilderness where there is no way.
25 They grope in the dark without light.
He makes them stagger like a drunken man.

13

1 "Behold, my eye has seen all this.
My ear has heard and understood it.
2 What you know, I know also.
I am not inferior to you.

3 "Surely I would speak to the Almighty.
I desire to reason with God.
4 But you are forgers of lies.
You are all physicians of no value.
5 Oh that you would be completely silent!
Then you would be wise.
6 Hear now my reasoning.
Listen to the pleadings of my lips.
7 Will you speak unrighteously for God,
and talk deceitfully for him?
8 Will you show partiality to him?
Will you contend for God?
9 Is it good that he should search you out?
Or as one deceives a man, will you deceive him?
10 He will surely reprove you
if you secretly show partiality.
11 Won't his majesty make you afraid
and his dread fall on you?
12 Your memorable sayings are proverbs of ashes.
Your defenses are defenses of clay.

13 "Be silent!
Leave me alone, that I may speak.
Let come on me what will.
14 Why should I take my flesh in my teeth,
and put my life in my hand?
15 Behold, he will kill me.
I have no hope.
Nevertheless, I will maintain my ways before him.
16 This also will be my salvation,
that a godless man will not come before him.
17 Listen carefully to my speech.
Let my declaration be in your ears.
18 See now, I have set my cause in order.
I know that I am righteous.
19 Who is he who will contend with me?
For then I would hold my peace and give up the spirit.

20 "Only don't do two things to me,
then I will not hide myself from your face:
21 withdraw your hand far from me,
and don't let your terror make me afraid.
22 Then call, and I will answer,
or let me speak, and you answer me.
23 How many are my iniquities and sins?
Make me know my disobedience and my sin.
24 Why do you hide your face,
and consider me your enemy?
25 Will you harass a driven leaf?
Will you pursue the dry stubble?
26 For you write bitter things against me,
and make me inherit the iniquities of my youth.

27 You also put my feet in the stocks,
and mark all my paths.
You set a bound to the soles of my feet,
28 though I am decaying like a rotten thing,
like a garment that is moth-eaten.

14

1 "Man, who is born of a woman,
is of few days, and full of trouble.
2 He grows up like a flower, and is cut
down.
He also flees like a shadow, and
doesn't continue.
3 Do you open your eyes on such a one,
and bring me into judgment with
you?
4 Who can bring a clean thing out of an
unclean?
Not one.
5 Seeing his days are determined,
the number of his months is with you,
and you have appointed his bounds
that he can't pass.
6 Look away from him, that he may rest,
until he accomplishes, as a hireling,
his day.

7 "For there is hope for a tree if it is cut
down,
that it will sprout again,
that the tender branch of it will not
cease.
8 Though its root grows old in the earth,
and its stock dies in the ground,
9 yet through the scent of water it will bud,
and sprout boughs like a plant.
10 But man dies, and is laid low.
Yes, man gives up the spirit, and
where is he?
11 As the waters fail from the sea,
and the river wastes and dries up,
12 so man lies down and doesn't rise.
Until the heavens are no more, they
will not awake,
nor be roused out of their sleep.

13 "Oh that you would hide me in Sheol,†
that you would keep me secret until
your wrath is past,
that you would appoint me a set time
and remember me!
14 If a man dies, will he live again?
I would wait all the days of my
warfare,
until my release should come.
15 You would call, and I would answer you.
You would have a desire for the work
of your hands.
16 But now you count my steps.
Don't you watch over my sin?
17 My disobedience is sealed up in a bag.
You fasten up my iniquity.

18 "But the mountain falling comes to
nothing.
The rock is removed out of its place.
19 The waters wear the stones.
The torrents of it wash away the dust
of the earth.
So you destroy the hope of man.
20 You forever prevail against him, and he
departs.
You change his face, and send him
away.
21 His sons come to honor, and he doesn't
know it.
They are brought low, but he doesn't
perceive it of them.
22 But his flesh on him has pain,
and his soul within him mourns."

15

1 Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered,
2 "Should a wise man answer with vain
knowledge,
and fill himself with the east wind?
3 Should he reason with unprofitable talk,
or with speeches with which he can
do no good?
4 Yes, you do away with fear,
and hinder devotion before God.
5 For your iniquity teaches your mouth,
and you choose the language of the
crafty.
6 Your own mouth condemns you, and not
I.
Yes, your own lips testify against you.

7 "Are you the first man who was born?

† **14:13** Sheol is the place of the dead.

Or were you brought out before the hills?
8 Have you heard the secret counsel of God?
Do you limit wisdom to yourself?
9 What do you know that we don't know?
What do you understand which is not in us?
10 With us are both the gray-headed and the very aged men,
much older than your father.
11 Are the consolations of God too small for you,
even the word that is gentle toward you?
12 Why does your heart carry you away?
Why do your eyes flash,
13 that you turn your spirit against God,
and let such words go out of your mouth?
14 What is man, that he should be clean?
What is he who is born of a woman, that he should be righteous?
15 Behold, he puts no trust in his holy ones.
Yes, the heavens are not clean in his sight;
16 how much less one who is abominable and corrupt,
a man who drinks iniquity like water!

17 "I will show you, listen to me;
that which I have seen I will declare
18 (which wise men have told by their fathers,
and have not hidden it;
19 to whom alone the land was given,
and no stranger passed among them):
20 the wicked man writhes in pain all his days,
even the number of years that are laid up for the oppressor.
21 A sound of terrors is in his ears.
In prosperity the destroyer will come on him.
22 He doesn't believe that he will return out of darkness.
He is waited for by the sword.
23 He wanders abroad for bread, saying, 'Where is it?'
He knows that the day of darkness is ready at his hand.
24 Distress and anguish make him afraid.
They prevail against him, as a king ready to the battle.
25 Because he has stretched out his hand against God,
and behaves himself proudly against the Almighty,
26 he runs at him with a stiff neck,
with the thick shields of his bucklers,
27 because he has covered his face with his fatness,
and gathered fat on his thighs.
28 He has lived in desolate cities,
in houses which no one inhabited,
which were ready to become heaps.
29 He will not be rich, neither will his substance continue,
neither will their possessions be extended on the earth.
30 He will not depart out of darkness.
The flame will dry up his branches.
He will go away by the breath of God's mouth.
31 Let him not trust in emptiness, deceiving himself,
for emptiness will be his reward.
32 It will be accomplished before his time.
His branch will not be green.
33 He will shake off his unripe grape as the vine,
and will cast off his flower as the olive tree.
34 For the company of the godless will be barren,
and fire will consume the tents of bribery.
35 They conceive mischief and produce iniquity.
Their heart prepares deceit."

16

1 Then Job answered,
2 "I have heard many such things.
You are all miserable comforters!
3 Shall vain words have an end?
Or what provokes you that you answer?
4 I also could speak as you do.
If your soul were in my soul's place,
I could join words together against you,
and shake my head at you,

5 but I would strengthen you with my
mouth.
The solace of my lips would relieve
you.

6 “Though I speak, my grief is not
subsided.
Though I forbear, what am I eased?
7 But now, God, you have surely worn me
out.
You have made all my company
desolate.
8 You have shriveled me up. This is a
witness against me.
My leanness rises up against me.
It testifies to my face.
9 He has torn me in his wrath and
persecuted me.
He has gnashed on me with his teeth.
My adversary sharpens his eyes on
me.
10 They have gaped on me with their
mouth.
They have struck me on the cheek
reproachfully.
They gather themselves together
against me.
11 God delivers me to the ungodly,
and casts me into the hands of the
wicked.
12 I was at ease, and he broke me apart.
Yes, he has taken me by the neck, and
dashed me to pieces.
He has also set me up for his target.
13 His archers surround me.
He splits my kidneys apart, and does
not spare.
He pours out my bile on the ground.
14 He breaks me with breach on breach.
He runs at me like a giant.
15 I have sewed sackcloth on my skin,
and have thrust my horn in the dust.
16 My face is red with weeping.
Deep darkness is on my eyelids,
17 although there is no violence in my
hands,
and my prayer is pure.

18 “Earth, don’t cover my blood.
Let my cry have no place to rest.
19 Even now, behold, my witness is in
heaven.
He who vouches for me is on high.
20 My friends scoff at me.
My eyes pour out tears to God,
21 that he would maintain the right of a
man with God,
of a son of man with his neighbor!
22 For when a few years have come,
I will go the way of no return.

17

1 “My spirit is consumed.
My days are extinct
and the grave is ready for me.
2 Surely there are mockers with me.
My eye dwells on their provocation.

3 “Now give a pledge. Be collateral for me
with yourself.
Who is there who will strike hands
with me?
4 For you have hidden their heart from
understanding,
therefore you will not exalt them.
5 He who denounces his friends for
plunder,
even the eyes of his children will fail.

6 “But he has made me a byword of the
people.
They spit in my face.
7 My eye also is dim by reason of sorrow.
All my members are as a shadow.
8 Upright men will be astonished at this.
The innocent will stir himself up
against the godless.
9 Yet the righteous will hold to his way.
He who has clean hands will grow
stronger and stronger.
10 But as for you all, come back.
I will not find a wise man among you.
11 My days are past.
My plans are broken off,
as are the thoughts of my heart.
12 They change the night into day,
saying ‘The light is near’ in the
presence of darkness.
13 If I look for Sheol† as my house,
if I have spread my couch in the
darkness,

† **17:13** Sheol is the place of the dead.

14 if I have said to corruption, ‘You are my
father,’
and to the worm, ‘My mother,’ and
‘My sister,’
15 where then is my hope?
As for my hope, who will see it?
16 Shall it go down with me to the gates of
Sheol,‡
or descend together into the dust?”

18

1 Then Bildad the Shuhite answered,
2 “How long will you hunt for words?
Consider, and afterwards we will
speak.
3 Why are we counted as animals,
which have become unclean in your
sight?
4 You who tear yourself in your anger,
will the earth be forsaken for you?
Or will the rock be removed out of its
place?

5 “Yes, the light of the wicked will be put
out.
The spark of his fire won’t shine.
6 The light will be dark in his tent.
His lamp above him will be put out.
7 The steps of his strength will be
shortened.
His own counsel will cast him down.
8 For he is cast into a net by his own feet,
and he wanders into its mesh.
9 A snare will take him by the heel.
A trap will catch him.
10 A noose is hidden for him in the ground,
a trap for him on the path.
11 Terrors will make him afraid on every
side,
and will chase him at his heels.
12 His strength will be famished.
Calamity will be ready at his side.
13 The members of his body will be
devoured.
The firstborn of death will devour his
members.
14 He will be rooted out of the security of
his tent.
He will be brought to the king of
terrors.
15 There will dwell in his tent that which is
none of his.
Sulfur will be scattered on his
habitation.
16 His roots will be dried up beneath.
His branch will be cut off above.
17 His memory will perish from the earth.
He will have no name in the street.
18 He will be driven from light into
darkness,
and chased out of the world.
19 He will have neither son nor grandson
among his people,
nor any remaining where he lived.
20 Those who come after will be
astonished at his day,
as those who went before were
frightened.
21 Surely such are the dwellings of the
unrighteous.
This is the place of him who doesn’t
know God.”

19

1 Then Job answered,
2 “How long will you torment me,
and crush me with words?
3 You have reproached me ten times.
You aren’t ashamed that you attack
me.
4 If it is true that I have erred,
my error remains with myself.
5 If indeed you will magnify yourselves
against me,
and plead against me my reproach,
6 know now that God has subverted me,
and has surrounded me with his net.

7 “Behold, I cry out of wrong, but I am not
heard.
I cry for help, but there is no justice.
8 He has walled up my way so that I can’t
pass,
and has set darkness in my paths.
9 He has stripped me of my glory,
and taken the crown from my head.
10 He has broken me down on every side,
and I am gone.
He has plucked my hope up like a tree.
11 He has also kindled his wrath against
me.
He counts me among his adversaries.
12 His troops come on together,

‡ **17:16** Sheol is the place of the dead.

build a siege ramp against me,
and encamp around my tent.

13 "He has put my brothers far from me.
My acquaintances are wholly
estranged from me.
14 My relatives have gone away.
My familiar friends have forgotten
me.
15 Those who dwell in my house and my
maids consider me a stranger.
I am an alien in their sight.
16 I call to my servant, and he gives me no
answer.
I beg him with my mouth.
17 My breath is offensive to my wife.
I am loathsome to the children of my
own mother.
18 Even young children despise me.
If I arise, they speak against me.
19 All my familiar friends abhor me.
They whom I loved have turned
against me.
20 My bones stick to my skin and to my
flesh.
I have escaped by the skin of my teeth.

21 "Have pity on me. Have pity on me, you
my friends,
for the hand of God has touched me.
22 Why do you persecute me as God,
and are not satisfied with my flesh?

23 "Oh that my words were now written!
Oh that they were inscribed in a book!
24 That with an iron pen and lead
they were engraved in the rock
forever!
25 But as for me, I know that my Redeemer
lives.
In the end, he will stand upon the
earth.
26 After my skin is destroyed,
then I will see God in my flesh,
27 whom I, even I, will see on my side.
My eyes will see, and not as a
stranger.

"My heart is consumed within me.
28 If you say, 'How we will persecute him!'
because the root of the matter is
found in me,
29 be afraid of the sword,
for wrath brings the punishments of
the sword,
that you may know there is a
judgment."

20

1 Then Zophar the Naamathite
answered,
2 "Therefore my thoughts answer me,
even by reason of my haste that is in
me.
3 I have heard the reproof which puts me
to shame.
The spirit of my understanding
answers me.
4 Don't you know this from old time,
since man was placed on earth,
5 that the triumphing of the wicked is
short,
the joy of the godless but for a
moment?
6 Though his height mount up to the
heavens,
and his head reach to the clouds,
7 yet he will perish forever like his own
dung.
Those who have seen him will say,
'Where is he?'
8 He will fly away as a dream, and will not
be found.
Yes, he will be chased away like a
vision of the night.
9 The eye which saw him will see him no
more,
neither will his place see him any
more.
10 His children will seek the favor of the
poor.
His hands will give back his wealth.
11 His bones are full of his youth,
but youth will lie down with him in
the dust.

12 "Though wickedness is sweet in his
mouth,
though he hide it under his tongue,
13 though he spare it, and will not let it go,
but keep it still within his mouth,
14 yet his food in his bowels is turned.
It is cobra venom within him.
15 He has swallowed down riches, and he
will vomit them up again.
God will cast them out of his belly.
16 He will suck cobra venom.

The viper's tongue will kill him.
17 He will not look at the rivers,
the flowing streams of honey and butter.
18 He will restore that for which he labored, and will not swallow it down.
He will not rejoice according to the substance that he has gotten.
19 For he has oppressed and forsaken the poor.
He has violently taken away a house, and he will not build it up.

20 "Because he knew no quietness within him,
he will not save anything of that in which he delights.
21 There was nothing left that he didn't devour,
therefore his prosperity will not endure.
22 In the fullness of his sufficiency, distress will overtake him.
The hand of everyone who is in misery will come on him.
23 When he is about to fill his belly, God will cast the fierceness of his wrath on him.
It will rain on him while he is eating.
24 He will flee from the iron weapon.
The bronze arrow will strike him through.
25 He draws it out, and it comes out of his body.
Yes, the glittering point comes out of his liver.
Terrors are on him.
26 All darkness is laid up for his treasures.
An unfanned fire will devour him.
It will consume that which is left in his tent.
27 The heavens will reveal his iniquity.
The earth will rise up against him.
28 The increase of his house will depart.
They will rush away in the day of his wrath.
29 This is the portion of a wicked man from God,
the heritage appointed to him by God."

21

1 Then Job answered,
2 "Listen diligently to my speech.
Let this be your consolation.
3 Allow me, and I also will speak.
After I have spoken, mock on.
4 As for me, is my complaint to man?
Why shouldn't I be impatient?
5 Look at me, and be astonished.
Lay your hand on your mouth.
6 When I remember, I am troubled.
Horror takes hold of my flesh.

7 "Why do the wicked live,
become old, yes, and grow mighty in power?
8 Their child is established with them in their sight,
their offspring before their eyes.
9 Their houses are safe from fear,
neither is the rod of God upon them.
10 Their bulls breed without fail.
Their cows calve, and don't miscarry.
11 They send out their little ones like a flock.
Their children dance.
12 They sing to the tambourine and harp,
and rejoice at the sound of the pipe.
13 They spend their days in prosperity.
In an instant they go down to Sheol.†
14 They tell God, 'Depart from us,
for we don't want to know about your ways.
15 What is the Almighty, that we should serve him?
What profit should we have, if we pray to him?'
16 Behold, their prosperity is not in their hand.
The counsel of the wicked is far from me.

17 "How often is it that the lamp of the wicked is put out,
that their calamity comes on them,
that God distributes sorrows in his anger?
18 How often is it that they are as stubble before the wind,
as chaff that the storm carries away?

† **21:13** Sheol is the place of the dead.

19 You say, ‘God lays up his iniquity for his children.’
Let him recompense it to himself, that he may know it.
20 Let his own eyes see his destruction.
Let him drink of the wrath of the Almighty.
21 For what does he care for his house after him,
when the number of his months is cut off?

22 “Shall any teach God knowledge,
since he judges those who are high?
23 One dies in his full strength,
being wholly at ease and quiet.
24 His pails are full of milk.
The marrow of his bones is moistened.
25 Another dies in bitterness of soul,
and never tastes of good.
26 They lie down alike in the dust.
The worm covers them.

27 “Behold, I know your thoughts,
the plans with which you would wrong me.
28 For you say, ‘Where is the house of the prince?
Where is the tent in which the wicked lived?’
29 Haven’t you asked wayfaring men?
Don’t you know their evidences,
30 that the evil man is reserved to the day of calamity,
that they are led out to the day of wrath?
31 Who will declare his way to his face?
Who will repay him what he has done?
32 Yet he will be borne to the grave.
Men will keep watch over the tomb.
33 The clods of the valley will be sweet to him.
All men will draw after him,
as there were innumerable before him.
34 So how can you comfort me with nonsense,
because in your answers there remains only falsehood?”

22

1 Then Eliphaz the Temanite answered,
2 “Can a man be profitable to God?
Surely he who is wise is profitable to himself.
3 Is it any pleasure to the Almighty that you are righteous?
Or does it benefit him that you make your ways perfect?
4 Is it for your piety that he reproves you,
that he enters with you into judgment?
5 Isn’t your wickedness great?
Neither is there any end to your iniquities.
6 For you have taken pledges from your brother for nothing,
and stripped the naked of their clothing.
7 You haven’t given water to the weary to drink,
and you have withheld bread from the hungry.
8 But as for the mighty man, he had the earth.
The honorable man, he lived in it.
9 You have sent widows away empty,
and the arms of the fatherless have been broken.
10 Therefore snares are around you.
Sudden fear troubles you,
11 or darkness, so that you can not see,
and floods of waters cover you.

12 “Isn’t God in the heights of heaven?
See the height of the stars, how high they are!
13 You say, ‘What does God know?
Can he judge through the thick darkness?
14 Thick clouds are a covering to him, so that he doesn’t see.
He walks on the vault of the sky.’
15 Will you keep the old way,
which wicked men have trodden,
16 who were snatched away before their time,
whose foundation was poured out as a stream,
17 who said to God, ‘Depart from us!’
and, ‘What can the Almighty do for us?’
18 Yet he filled their houses with good things,

but the counsel of the wicked is far
from me.
19 The righteous see it, and are glad.
The innocent ridicule them,
20 saying, 'Surely those who rose up
against us are cut off.
The fire has consumed their
remnant.'

21 "Acquaint yourself with him now, and
be at peace.
By it, good will come to you.
22 Please receive instruction from his
mouth,
and lay up his words in your heart.
23 If you return to the Almighty, you will
be built up,
if you put away unrighteousness far
from your tents.
24 Lay your treasure in the dust,
the gold of Ophir among the stones of
the brooks.
25 The Almighty will be your treasure,
and precious silver to you.
26 For then you will delight yourself in the
Almighty,
and will lift up your face to God.
27 You will make your prayer to him, and
he will hear you.
You will pay your vows.
28 You will also decree a thing, and it will
be established to you.
Light will shine on your ways.
29 When they cast down, you will say, 'be
lifted up.'
He will save the humble person.
30 He will even deliver him who is not
innocent.
Yes, he will be delivered through the
cleanness of your hands."

23

1 Then Job answered,
2 "Even today my complaint is rebellious.
His hand is heavy in spite of my
groaning.
3 Oh that I knew where I might find him!
That I might come even to his seat!
4 I would set my cause in order before
him,
and fill my mouth with arguments.
5 I would know the words which he would
answer me,
and understand what he would tell
me.
6 Would he contend with me in the
greatness of his power?
No, but he would listen to me.
7 There the upright might reason with
him,
so I should be delivered forever from
my judge.

8 "If I go east, he is not there.
If I go west, I can't find him.
9 He works to the north, but I can't see
him.
He turns south, but I can't catch a
glimpse of him.

10 But he knows the way that I take.
When he has tried me, I will come out
like gold.
11 My foot has held fast to his steps.
I have kept his way, and not turned
away.
12 I haven't gone back from the
commandment of his lips.
I have treasured up the words of his
mouth more than my necessary
food.
13 But he stands alone, and who can
oppose him?
What his soul desires, even that he
does.
14 For he performs that which is
appointed for me.
Many such things are with him.
15 Therefore I am terrified at his presence.
When I consider, I am afraid of him.
16 For God has made my heart faint.
The Almighty has terrified me.
17 Because I was not cut off before the
darkness,
neither did he cover the thick
darkness from my face.

24

1 "Why aren't times laid up by the
Almighty?
Why don't those who know him see
his days?

2 There are people who remove the
landmarks.
They violently take away flocks, and
feed them.
3 They drive away the donkey of the
fatherless,
and they take the widow's ox for a
pledge.
4 They turn the needy out of the way.
The poor of the earth all hide
themselves.
5 Behold, as wild donkeys in the desert,
they go out to their work, seeking
diligently for food.
The wilderness yields them bread for
their children.
6 They cut their food in the field.
They glean the vineyard of the wicked.
7 They lie all night naked without
clothing,
and have no covering in the cold.
8 They are wet with the showers of the
mountains,
and embrace the rock for lack of a shelter.
9 There are those who pluck the
fatherless from the breast,
and take a pledge of the poor,
10 so that they go around naked
without clothing.
Being hungry, they carry the sheaves.
11 They make oil within the walls of these
men.
They tread wine presses, and suffer
thirst.
12 From out of the populous city, men
groan.
The soul of the wounded cries out,
yet God doesn't regard the folly.

13 "These are of those who rebel against
the light.
They don't know its ways,
nor stay in its paths.
14 The murderer rises with the light.
He kills the poor and needy.
In the night he is like a thief.
15 The eye also of the adulterer waits for
the twilight,
saying, 'No eye will see me.'
He disguises his face.
16 In the dark they dig through houses.
They shut themselves up in the
daytime.
They don't know the light.
17 For the morning is to all of them like
thick darkness,
for they know the terrors of the thick
darkness.

18 "They are foam on the surface of the
waters.
Their portion is cursed in the earth.
They don't turn into the way of the
vineyards.
19 Drought and heat consume the snow
waters,
so does Sheol† those who have sinned.
20 The womb will forget him.
The worm will feed sweetly on him.
He will be no more remembered.
Unrighteousness will be broken as a
tree.
21 He devours the barren who don't bear.
He shows no kindness to the widow.
22 Yet God preserves the mighty by his
power.
He rises up who has no assurance of
life.
23 God gives them security, and they rest
in it.
His eyes are on their ways.
24 They are exalted; yet a little while, and
they are gone.
Yes, they are brought low, they are
taken out of the way as all others,
and are cut off as the tops of the ears
of grain.
25 If it isn't so now, who will prove me a
liar,
and make my speech worth nothing?"

25

1 Then Bildad the Shuhite answered,
2 "Dominion and fear are with him.
He makes peace in his high places.
3 Can his armies be counted?
On whom does his light not arise?
4 How then can man be just with God?
Or how can he who is born of a
woman be clean?
5 Behold, even the moon has no
brightness,
and the stars are not pure in his sight;

† **24:19** Sheol is the place of the dead.

6 How much less man, who is a worm,
and the son of man, who is a worm!"

26

1 Then Job answered,
2 "How have you helped him who is without power!
How have you saved the arm that has no strength!
3 How have you counseled him who has no wisdom,
and plentifully declared sound knowledge!
4 To whom have you uttered words?
Whose spirit came out of you?

5 "The departed spirits tremble,
those beneath the waters and all that live in them.
6 Sheol† is naked before God,
and Abaddon‡ has no covering.
7 He stretches out the north over empty space,
and hangs the earth on nothing.
8 He binds up the waters in his thick clouds,
and the cloud is not burst under them.
9 He encloses the face of his throne,
and spreads his cloud on it.
10 He has described a boundary on the surface of the waters,
and to the confines of light and darkness.
11 The pillars of heaven tremble
and are astonished at his rebuke.
12 He stirs up the sea with his power,
and by his understanding he strikes through Rahab.
13 By his Spirit the heavens are garnished.
His hand has pierced the swift serpent.
14 Behold, these are but the outskirts of his ways.
How small a whisper do we hear of him!
But the thunder of his power who can understand?"

27

1 Job again took up his parable, and said,
2 "As God lives, who has taken away my right,
the Almighty, who has made my soul bitter
3 (for the length of my life is still in me,
and the spirit of God is in my nostrils);
4 surely my lips will not speak unrighteousness,
neither will my tongue utter deceit.
5 Far be it from me that I should justify you.
Until I die I will not put away my integrity from me.
6 I hold fast to my righteousness, and will not let it go.
My heart will not reproach me so long as I live.

7 "Let my enemy be as the wicked.
Let him who rises up against me be as the unrighteous.

8 For what is the hope of the godless, when he is cut off,
when God takes away his life?
9 Will God hear his cry when trouble comes on him?
10 Will he delight himself in the Almighty,
and call on God at all times?
11 I will teach you about the hand of God.
I will not conceal that which is with the Almighty.
12 Behold, all of you have seen it yourselves;
why then have you become altogether vain?

13 "This is the portion of a wicked man with God,
the heritage of oppressors, which they receive from the Almighty.
14 If his children are multiplied, it is for the sword.
His offspring will not be satisfied with bread.
15 Those who remain of him will be buried in death.
His widows will make no lamentation.
16 Though he heap up silver as the dust,
and prepare clothing as the clay;
17 he may prepare it, but the just will put it on,

† **26:6** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **26:6** Abaddon means Destroyer.

and the innocent will divide the silver.
18 He builds his house as the moth,
as a booth which the watchman makes.
19 He lies down rich, but he will not do so again.
He opens his eyes, and he is not.
20 Terrors overtake him like waters.
A storm steals him away in the night.
21 The east wind carries him away, and he departs.
It sweeps him out of his place.
22 For it hurls at him, and does not spare,
as he flees away from his hand.
23 Men will clap their hands at him,
and will hiss him out of his place.

28

1 "Surely there is a mine for silver,
and a place for gold which they refine.
2 Iron is taken out of the earth,
and copper is smelted out of the ore.
3 Man sets an end to darkness,
and searches out, to the furthest bound,
the stones of obscurity and of thick darkness.
4 He breaks open a shaft away from where people live.
They are forgotten by the foot.
They hang far from men, they swing back and forth.
5 As for the earth, out of it comes bread.
Underneath it is turned up as it were by fire.
6 Sapphires come from its rocks.
It has dust of gold.
7 That path no bird of prey knows,
neither has the falcon's eye seen it.
8 The proud animals have not trodden it,
nor has the fierce lion passed by there.
9 He puts his hand on the flinty rock,
and he overturns the mountains by the roots.
10 He cuts out channels among the rocks.
His eye sees every precious thing.
11 He binds the streams that they don't trickle.
The thing that is hidden he brings out to light.

12 "But where will wisdom be found?
Where is the place of understanding?
13 Man doesn't know its price,
and it isn't found in the land of the living.
14 The deep says, 'It isn't in me.'
The sea says, 'It isn't with me.'
15 It can't be gotten for gold,
neither will silver be weighed for its price.
16 It can't be valued with the gold of Ophir,
with the precious onyx, or the sapphire.†
17 Gold and glass can't equal it,
neither will it be exchanged for jewels of fine gold.
18 No mention will be made of coral or of crystal.
Yes, the price of wisdom is above rubies.
19 The topaz of Ethiopia will not equal it.
It won't be valued with pure gold.
20 Where then does wisdom come from?
Where is the place of understanding?
21 Seeing it is hidden from the eyes of all living,
and kept close from the birds of the sky.
22 Destruction and Death say,
'We have heard a rumor of it with our ears.'

23 "God understands its way,
and he knows its place.
24 For he looks to the ends of the earth,
and sees under the whole sky.
25 He establishes the force of the wind.
Yes, he measures out the waters by measure.
26 When he made a decree for the rain,
and a way for the lightning of the thunder,
27 then he saw it, and declared it.
He established it, yes, and searched it out.
28 To man he said,

† **28:16** or, lapis lazuli ‡ **28:28** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai."

‘Behold, the fear of the Lord,‡ that is wisdom.
To depart from evil is understanding.’ ”

29

1 Job again took up his parable, and said,
2 “Oh that I were as in the months of old,
as in the days when God watched over me;
3 when his lamp shone on my head,
and by his light I walked through darkness,
4 as I was in my prime,
when the friendship of God was in my tent,
5 when the Almighty was yet with me,
and my children were around me,
6 when my steps were washed with butter,
and the rock poured out streams of oil for me,
7 when I went out to the city gate,
when I prepared my seat in the street.
8 The young men saw me and hid themselves.
The aged rose up and stood.
9 The princes refrained from talking,
and laid their hand on their mouth.
10 The voice of the nobles was hushed,
and their tongue stuck to the roof of their mouth.
11 For when the ear heard me, then it blessed me,
and when the eye saw me, it commended me,
12 because I delivered the poor who cried,
and the fatherless also, who had no one to help him,
13 the blessing of him who was ready to perish came on me,
and I caused the widow’s heart to sing for joy.
14 I put on righteousness, and it clothed me.
My justice was as a robe and a diadem.
15 I was eyes to the blind,
and feet to the lame.
16 I was a father to the needy.
I researched the cause of him whom I didn’t know.
17 I broke the jaws of the unrighteous
and plucked the prey out of his teeth.
18 Then I said, ‘I will die in my own house,
I will count my days as the sand.
19 My root is spread out to the waters.
The dew lies all night on my branch.
20 My glory is fresh in me.
My bow is renewed in my hand.’

21 “Men listened to me, waited,
and kept silence for my counsel.
22 After my words they didn’t speak again.
My speech fell on them.
23 They waited for me as for the rain.
Their mouths drank as with the spring rain.
24 I smiled on them when they had no confidence.
They didn’t reject the light of my face.
25 I chose out their way, and sat as chief.
I lived as a king in the army,
as one who comforts the mourners.

30

1 “But now those who are younger than I have me in derision,
whose fathers I considered unworthy to put with my sheep dogs.
2 Of what use is the strength of their hands to me,
men in whom ripe age has perished?
3 They are gaunt from lack and famine.
They gnaw the dry ground, in the gloom of waste and desolation.
4 They pluck salt herbs by the bushes.
The roots of the broom tree are their food.
5 They are driven out from among men.
They cry after them as after a thief,
6 so that they live in frightful valleys,
and in holes of the earth and of the rocks.
7 They bray among the bushes.
They are gathered together under the nettles.
8 They are children of fools, yes, children of wicked men.
They were flogged out of the land.

9 “Now I have become their song.
Yes, I am a byword to them.

10 They abhor me, they stand aloof from me,
and don't hesitate to spit in my face.
11 For he has untied his cord, and afflicted me;
and they have thrown off restraint before me.
12 On my right hand rise the rabble.
They thrust aside my feet.
They cast their ways of destruction up against me.
13 They mar my path.
They promote my destruction without anyone's help.
14 As through a wide breach they come.
They roll themselves in amid the ruin.
15 Terrors have turned on me.
They chase my honor as the wind.
My welfare has passed away as a cloud.

16 "Now my soul is poured out within me.
Days of affliction have taken hold of me.
17 In the night season my bones are pierced in me,
and the pains that gnaw me take no rest.
18 My garment is disfigured by great force.
It binds me about as the collar of my tunic.
19 He has cast me into the mire.
I have become like dust and ashes.
20 I cry to you, and you do not answer me.
I stand up, and you gaze at me.
21 You have turned to be cruel to me.
With the might of your hand you persecute me.
22 You lift me up to the wind, and drive me with it.
You dissolve me in the storm.
23 For I know that you will bring me to death,
to the house appointed for all living.

24 "However doesn't one stretch out a hand in his fall?
Or in his calamity therefore cry for help?
25 Didn't I weep for him who was in trouble?
Wasn't my soul grieved for the needy?
26 When I looked for good, then evil came.
When I waited for light, darkness came.
27 My heart is troubled, and doesn't rest.
Days of affliction have come on me.
28 I go mourning without the sun.
I stand up in the assembly, and cry for help.
29 I am a brother to jackals,
and a companion to ostriches.
30 My skin grows black and peels from me.
My bones are burned with heat.
31 Therefore my harp has turned to mourning,
and my pipe into the voice of those who weep.

31

1 "I made a covenant with my eyes;
how then should I look lustfully at a young woman?
2 For what is the portion from God above,
and the heritage from the Almighty on high?
3 Is it not calamity to the unrighteous,
and disaster to the workers of iniquity?
4 Doesn't he see my ways,
and count all my steps?

5 "If I have walked with falsehood,
and my foot has hurried to deceit
6 (let me be weighed in an even balance,
that God may know my integrity);
7 if my step has turned out of the way,
if my heart walked after my eyes,
if any defilement has stuck to my hands,
8 then let me sow, and let another eat.
Yes, let the produce of my field be rooted out.

9 "If my heart has been enticed to a woman,
and I have laid wait at my neighbor's door,
10 then let my wife grind for another,
and let others sleep with her.
11 For that would be a heinous crime.
Yes, it would be an iniquity to be punished by the judges,

12 for it is a fire that consumes to
destruction,
and would root out all my increase.
13 “If I have despised the cause of my male
servant
or of my female servant,
when they contended with me,
14 what then will I do when God rises up?
When he visits, what will I answer
him?
15 Didn’t he who made me in the womb
make him?
Didn’t one fashion us in the womb?
16 “If I have withheld the poor from their
desire,
or have caused the eyes of the widow
to fail,
17 or have eaten my morsel alone,
and the fatherless has not eaten of it
18 (no, from my youth he grew up with me
as with a father,
I have guided her from my mother’s
womb);
19 if I have seen any perish for want of
clothing,
or that the needy had no covering;
20 if his heart hasn’t blessed me,
if he hasn’t been warmed with my
sheep’s fleece;
21 if I have lifted up my hand against the
fatherless,
because I saw my help in the gate;
22 then let my shoulder fall from the
shoulder blade,
and my arm be broken from the bone.
23 For calamity from God is a terror to me.
Because of his majesty, I can do
nothing.
24 “If I have made gold my hope,
and have said to the fine gold, ‘You
are my confidence;’
25 If I have rejoiced because my wealth
was great,
and because my hand had gotten
much;
26 if I have seen the sun when it shined,
or the moon moving in splendor,
27 and my heart has been secretly enticed,
and my hand threw a kiss from my
mouth;
28 this also would be an iniquity to be
punished by the judges,
for I would have denied the God who
is above.
29 “If I have rejoiced at the destruction of
him who hated me,
or lifted up myself when evil found
him
30 (I have certainly not allowed my mouth
to sin
by asking his life with a curse);
31 if the men of my tent have not said,
‘Who can find one who has not been
filled with his meat?’
32 (the foreigner has not camped in the
street,
but I have opened my doors to the
traveler);
33 if like Adam I have covered my
transgressions,
by hiding my iniquity in my heart,
34 because I feared the great multitude,
and the contempt of families terrified
me,
so that I kept silence, and didn’t go out
of the door—
35 oh that I had one to hear me!
Behold, here is my signature! Let the
Almighty answer me!
Let the accuser write my indictment!
36 Surely I would carry it on my shoulder,
and I would bind it to me as a crown.
37 I would declare to him the number of
my steps.
I would go near to him like a prince.
38 If my land cries out against me,
and its furrows weep together;
39 if I have eaten its fruits without money,
or have caused its owners to lose
their life,
40 let briers grow instead of wheat,
and stinkweed instead of barley.”

The words of Job are ended.

32

1 So these three men ceased to answer
Job, because he was righteous in his own
eyes.
2 Then the wrath of Elihu the son of
Barachel, the Buzite, of the family of Ram,
was kindled against Job. His wrath was
kindled because he justified himself
rather than God.

3 Also his wrath was kindled against his
three friends, because they had found no
answer, and yet had condemned Job.
4 Now Elihu had waited to speak to Job,
because they were older than he.
5 When Elihu saw that there was no
answer in the mouth of these three men,
his wrath was kindled.

6 Elihu the son of Barachel the Buzite
answered,
"I am young, and you are very old.
Therefore I held back, and didn't dare
show you my opinion.
7 I said, 'Days should speak,
and multitude of years should teach
wisdom.'
8 But there is a spirit in man,
and the Spirit† of the Almighty gives
them understanding.
9 It is not the great who are wise,
nor the aged who understand justice.
10 Therefore I said, 'Listen to me;
I also will show my opinion.'

11 "Behold, I waited for your words,
and I listened for your reasoning,
while you searched out what to say.
12 Yes, I gave you my full attention,
but there was no one who convinced
Job,
or who answered his words, among
you.
13 Beware lest you say, 'We have found
wisdom.
God may refute him, not man;'
14 for he has not directed his words
against me;
neither will I answer him with your
speeches.

15 "They are amazed. They answer no
more.
They don't have a word to say.
16 Shall I wait, because they don't speak,
because they stand still, and answer
no more?
17 I also will answer my part,
and I also will show my opinion.
18 For I am full of words.
The spirit within me constrains me.
19 Behold, my breast is as wine which has
no vent;
like new wineskins it is ready to burst.
20 I will speak, that I may be refreshed.
I will open my lips and answer.
21 Please don't let me respect any man's
person,
neither will I give flattering titles to
any man.
22 For I don't know how to give flattering
titles,
or else my Maker would soon take me
away.

33

1 "However, Job, please hear my speech,
and listen to all my words.
2 See now, I have opened my mouth.
My tongue has spoken in my mouth.
3 My words will utter the uprightness of
my heart.
That which my lips know they will
speak sincerely.
4 The Spirit of God has made me,
and the breath of the Almighty gives
me life.
5 If you can, answer me.
Set your words in order before me,
and stand up.
6 Behold, I am toward God even as you are.
I am also formed out of the clay.
7 Behold, my terror will not make you
afraid,
neither will my pressure be heavy on
you.

8 "Surely you have spoken in my hearing,
I have heard the voice of your words,
saying,
9 'I am clean, without disobedience.
I am innocent, neither is there
iniquity in me.
10 Behold, he finds occasions against me.
He counts me for his enemy.
11 He puts my feet in the stocks.
He marks all my paths.'

12 "Behold, I will answer you. In this you
are not just,

† **32:8** or, breath

for God is greater than man.
13 Why do you strive against him,
because he doesn't give account of any of his matters?
14 For God speaks once,
yes twice, though man pays no attention.
15 In a dream, in a vision of the night,
when deep sleep falls on men,
in slumbering on the bed,
16 then he opens the ears of men,
and seals their instruction,
17 that he may withdraw man from his purpose,
and hide pride from man.
18 He keeps back his soul from the pit,
and his life from perishing by the sword.

19 "He is chastened also with pain on his bed,
with continual strife in his bones,
20 so that his life abhors bread,
and his soul dainty food.
21 His flesh is so consumed away that it can't be seen.
His bones that were not seen stick out.
22 Yes, his soul draws near to the pit,
and his life to the destroyers.

23 "If there is beside him an angel,
an interpreter, one among a thousand,
to show to man what is right for him,
24 then God is gracious to him, and says,
'Deliver him from going down to the pit,
I have found a ransom.'
25 His flesh will be fresher than a child's.
He returns to the days of his youth.
26 He prays to God, and he is favorable to him,
so that he sees his face with joy.
He restores to man his righteousness.
27 He sings before men, and says,
'I have sinned, and perverted that which was right,
and it didn't profit me.
28 He has redeemed my soul from going into the pit.
My life will see the light.'
29 "Behold, God does all these things,
twice, yes three times, with a man,
30 to bring back his soul from the pit,
that he may be enlightened with the light of the living.
31 Mark well, Job, and listen to me.
Hold your peace, and I will speak.
32 If you have anything to say, answer me.
Speak, for I desire to justify you.
33 If not, listen to me.
Hold your peace, and I will teach you wisdom."

34

1 Moreover Elihu answered,
2 "Hear my words, you wise men.
Give ear to me, you who have knowledge.
3 For the ear tries words,
as the palate tastes food.
4 Let us choose for us that which is right.
Let us know among ourselves what is good.
5 For Job has said, 'I am righteous,
God has taken away my right.
6 Notwithstanding my right I am considered a liar.
My wound is incurable, though I am without disobedience.'
7 What man is like Job,
who drinks scorn like water,
8 who goes in company with the workers of iniquity,
and walks with wicked men?
9 For he has said, 'It profits a man nothing that he should delight himself with God.'

10 "Therefore listen to me, you men of understanding:
far be it from God, that he should do wickedness,
from the Almighty, that he should commit iniquity.
11 For the work of a man he will give to him,
and cause every man to find according to his ways.
12 Yes surely, God will not do wickedly,
neither will the Almighty pervert justice.

13 Who put him in charge of the earth?
Or who has appointed him over the whole world?
14 If he set his heart on himself,
if he gathered to himself his spirit and his breath,
15 all flesh would perish together,
and man would turn again to dust.

16 "If now you have understanding, hear this.
Listen to the voice of my words.
17 Should even one who hates justice govern?
Will you condemn him who is righteous and mighty,
18 who says to a king, 'Vile!'
or to nobles, 'Wicked!'?
19 He doesn't respect the persons of princes,
nor respect the rich more than the poor,
for they all are the work of his hands.
20 In a moment they die, even at midnight.
The people are shaken and pass away.
The mighty are taken away without a hand.

21 "For his eyes are on the ways of a man.
He sees all his goings.
22 There is no darkness, nor thick gloom,
where the workers of iniquity may hide themselves.
23 For he doesn't need to consider a man further,
that he should go before God in judgment.
24 He breaks mighty men in pieces in ways past finding out,
and sets others in their place.
25 Therefore he takes knowledge of their works.
He overturns them in the night, so that they are destroyed.
26 He strikes them as wicked men
in the open sight of others;
27 because they turned away from following him,
and wouldn't pay attention to any of his ways,
28 so that they caused the cry of the poor to come to him.
He heard the cry of the afflicted.
29 When he gives quietness, who then can condemn?
When he hides his face, who then can see him?
He is over a nation or a man alike,
30 that the godless man may not reign,
that there be no one to ensnare the people.

31 "For has any said to God,
'I am guilty, but I will not offend any more.
32 Teach me that which I don't see.
If I have done iniquity, I will do it no more'?
33 Shall his recompense be as you desire, that you refuse it?
For you must choose, and not I.
Therefore speak what you know.
34 Men of understanding will tell me,
yes, every wise man who hears me:
35 'Job speaks without knowledge.
His words are without wisdom.'
36 I wish that Job were tried to the end,
because of his answering like wicked men.
37 For he adds rebellion to his sin.
He claps his hands among us,
and multiplies his words against God."

35

1 Moreover Elihu answered,
2 "Do you think this to be your right,
or do you say, 'My righteousness is more than God's,'
3 that you ask, 'What advantage will it be to you?
What profit will I have, more than if I had sinned?'
4 I will answer you,
and your companions with you.
5 Look to the skies, and see.
See the skies, which are higher than you.
6 If you have sinned, what effect do you have against him?
If your transgressions are multiplied, what do you do to him?
7 If you are righteous, what do you give him?

Or what does he receive from your hand?
8 Your wickedness may hurt a man as you are,
and your righteousness may profit a son of man.

9 “By reason of the multitude of oppressions they cry out.
They cry for help by reason of the arm of the mighty.
10 But no one says, ‘Where is God my Maker,
who gives songs in the night,
11 who teaches us more than the animals of the earth,
and makes us wiser than the birds of the sky?’
12 There they cry, but no one answers,
because of the pride of evil men.
13 Surely God will not hear an empty cry,
neither will the Almighty regard it.
14 How much less when you say you don’t see him.
The cause is before him, and you wait for him!
15 But now, because he has not visited in his anger,
neither does he greatly regard arrogance,
16 therefore Job opens his mouth with empty talk,
and he multiplies words without knowledge.”

36

1 Elihu also continued, and said,
2 “Bear with me a little, and I will show you;
for I still have something to say on God’s behalf.
3 I will get my knowledge from afar,
and will ascribe righteousness to my Maker.
4 For truly my words are not false.
One who is perfect in knowledge is with you.

5 “Behold, God is mighty, and doesn’t despise anyone.
He is mighty in strength of understanding.
6 He doesn’t preserve the life of the wicked,
but gives justice to the afflicted.
7 He doesn’t withdraw his eyes from the righteous,
but with kings on the throne,
he sets them forever, and they are exalted.
8 If they are bound in fetters,
and are taken in the cords of afflictions,
9 then he shows them their work,
and their transgressions, that they have behaved themselves proudly.
10 He also opens their ears to instruction,
and commands that they return from iniquity.
11 If they listen and serve him,
they will spend their days in prosperity,
and their years in pleasures.
12 But if they don’t listen, they will perish by the sword;
they will die without knowledge.

13 “But those who are godless in heart lay up anger.
They don’t cry for help when he binds them.
14 They die in youth.
Their life perishes among the unclean.
15 He delivers the afflicted by their affliction,
and opens their ear in oppression.
16 Yes, he would have allured you out of distress,
into a wide place, where there is no restriction.
That which is set on your table would be full of fatness.

17 “But you are full of the judgment of the wicked.
Judgment and justice take hold of you.
18 Don’t let riches entice you to wrath,
neither let the great size of a bribe turn you aside.
19 Would your wealth sustain you in distress,
or all the might of your strength?
20 Don’t desire the night,

when people are cut off in their place.
21 Take heed, don't regard iniquity;
for you have chosen this rather than affliction.
22 Behold, God is exalted in his power.
Who is a teacher like him?
23 Who has prescribed his way for him?
Or who can say, 'You have committed unrighteousness'?

24 "Remember that you magnify his work,
about which men have sung.
25 All men have looked on it.
Man sees it afar off.
26 Behold, God is great, and we don't know him.
The number of his years is unsearchable.
27 For he draws up the drops of water,
which distill in rain from his vapor,
28 which the skies pour down
and which drop on man abundantly.
29 Indeed, can anyone understand the spreading of the clouds
and the thunderings of his pavilion?
30 Behold, he spreads his light around him.
He covers the bottom of the sea.
31 For by these he judges the people.
He gives food in abundance.
32 He covers his hands with the lightning,
and commands it to strike the mark.
33 Its noise tells about him,
and the livestock also, concerning the storm that comes up.

37

1 "Yes, at this my heart trembles,
and is moved out of its place.
2 Hear, oh, hear the noise of his voice,
the sound that goes out of his mouth.
3 He sends it out under the whole sky,
and his lightning to the ends of the earth.
4 After it a voice roars.
He thunders with the voice of his majesty.
He doesn't hold back anything when his voice is heard.
5 God thunders marvelously with his voice.
He does great things, which we can't comprehend.
6 For he says to the snow, 'Fall on the earth,'
likewise to the shower of rain,
and to the showers of his mighty rain.
7 He seals up the hand of every man,
that all men whom he has made may know it.
8 Then the animals take cover,
and remain in their dens.
9 Out of its room comes the storm,
and cold out of the north.
10 By the breath of God, ice is given,
and the width of the waters is frozen.
11 Yes, he loads the thick cloud with moisture.
He spreads abroad the cloud of his lightning.
12 It is turned around by his guidance,
that they may do whatever he commands them
on the surface of the habitable world,
13 whether it is for correction, or for his land,
or for loving kindness, that he causes it to come.

14 "Listen to this, Job.
Stand still, and consider the wondrous works of God.
15 Do you know how God controls them,
and causes the lightning of his cloud to shine?
16 Do you know the workings of the clouds,
the wondrous works of him who is perfect in knowledge?
17 You whose clothing is warm
when the earth is still by reason of the south wind?
18 Can you, with him, spread out the sky,
which is strong as a cast metal mirror?
19 Teach us what we will tell him,
for we can't make our case by reason of darkness.
20 Will it be told him that I would speak?
Or should a man wish that he were swallowed up?

21 Now men don't see the light which is bright in the skies,
but the wind passes, and clears them.
22 Out of the north comes golden splendor.
With God is awesome majesty.
23 We can't reach the Almighty.

He is exalted in power.
In justice and great righteousness, he will not oppress.
24 Therefore men revere him.
He doesn't regard any who are wise of heart."

38

1 Then Yahweh answered Job out of the whirlwind,
2 "Who is this who darkens counsel
by words without knowledge?
3 Brace yourself like a man,
for I will question you, then you answer me!

4 "Where were you when I laid the foundations of the earth?
Declare, if you have understanding.
5 Who determined its measures, if you know?
Or who stretched the line on it?
6 What were its foundations fastened on?
Or who laid its cornerstone,
7 when the morning stars sang together,
and all the sons of God shouted for joy?

8 "Or who shut up the sea with doors,
when it broke out of the womb,
9 when I made clouds its garment,
and wrapped it in thick darkness,
10 marked out for it my bound,
set bars and doors,
11 and said, 'You may come here, but no further.
Your proud waves shall be stopped here'?

12 "Have you commanded the morning in your days,
and caused the dawn to know its place,
13 that it might take hold of the ends of the earth,
and shake the wicked out of it?
14 It is changed as clay under the seal,
and presented as a garment.
15 From the wicked, their light is withheld.
The high arm is broken.

16 "Have you entered into the springs of the sea?
Or have you walked in the recesses of the deep?
17 Have the gates of death been revealed to you?
Or have you seen the gates of the shadow of death?
18 Have you comprehended the earth in its width?
Declare, if you know it all.

19 "What is the way to the dwelling of light?
As for darkness, where is its place,
20 that you should take it to its bound,
that you should discern the paths to its house?
21 Surely you know, for you were born then,
and the number of your days is great!
22 Have you entered the storehouses of the snow,
or have you seen the storehouses of the hail,
23 which I have reserved against the time of trouble,
against the day of battle and war?
24 By what way is the lightning distributed,
or the east wind scattered on the earth?

25 Who has cut a channel for the flood water,
or the path for the thunderstorm,
26 to cause it to rain on a land where there is no man,
on the wilderness, in which there is no man,
27 to satisfy the waste and desolate ground,
to cause the tender grass to grow?
28 Does the rain have a father?
Or who fathers the drops of dew?
29 Whose womb did the ice come out of?
Who has given birth to the gray frost of the sky?
30 The waters become hard like stone,
when the surface of the deep is frozen.

31 "Can you bind the cluster of the Pleiades,
or loosen the cords of Orion?

32 Can you lead the constellations out in their season?
Or can you guide the Bear with her cubs?
33 Do you know the laws of the heavens?
Can you establish its dominion over the earth?

34 “Can you lift up your voice to the clouds,
that abundance of waters may cover you?
35 Can you send out lightnings, that they may go?
Do they report to you, ‘Here we are’?
36 Who has put wisdom in the inward parts?
Or who has given understanding to the mind?
37 Who can count the clouds by wisdom?
Or who can pour out the containers of the sky,
38 when the dust runs into a mass,
and the clods of earth stick together?

39 “Can you hunt the prey for the lioness,
or satisfy the appetite of the young lions,
40 when they crouch in their dens,
and lie in wait in the thicket?
41 Who provides for the raven his prey,
when his young ones cry to God,
and wander for lack of food?

39

1 “Do you know the time when the mountain goats give birth?
Do you watch when the doe bears fawns?
2 Can you count the months that they fulfill?
Or do you know the time when they give birth?
3 They bow themselves. They bear their young.
They end their labor pains.
4 Their young ones become strong.
They grow up in the open field.
They go out, and don’t return again.

5 “Who has set the wild donkey free?
Or who has loosened the bonds of the swift donkey,
6 whose home I have made the wilderness,
and the salt land his dwelling place?
7 He scorns the tumult of the city,
neither does he hear the shouting of the driver.
8 The range of the mountains is his pasture.
He searches after every green thing.

9 “Will the wild ox be content to serve you?
Or will he stay by your feeding trough?
10 Can you hold the wild ox in the furrow with his harness?
Or will he till the valleys after you?
11 Will you trust him, because his strength is great?
Or will you leave to him your labor?
12 Will you confide in him, that he will bring home your seed,
and gather the grain of your threshing floor?

13 “The wings of the ostrich wave proudly,
but are they the feathers and plumage of love?
14 For she leaves her eggs on the earth,
warms them in the dust,
15 and forgets that the foot may crush them,
or that the wild animal may trample them.
16 She deals harshly with her young ones, as if they were not hers.
Though her labor is in vain, she is without fear,
17 because God has deprived her of wisdom,
neither has he imparted to her understanding.
18 When she lifts up herself on high,
she scorns the horse and his rider.

19 “Have you given the horse might?
Have you clothed his neck with a quivering mane?
20 Have you made him to leap as a locust?
The glory of his snorting is awesome.
21 He paws in the valley, and rejoices in his strength.
He goes out to meet the armed men.
22 He mocks at fear, and is not dismayed,

neither does he turn back from the sword.
23 The quiver rattles against him,
the flashing spear and the javelin.
24 He eats up the ground with fierceness and rage,
neither does he stand still at the sound of the trumpet.
25 As often as the trumpet sounds he snorts, ‘Aha!’
He smells the battle afar off,
the thunder of the captains, and the shouting.

26 “Is it by your wisdom that the hawk soars,
and stretches her wings toward the south?
27 Is it at your command that the eagle mounts up,
and makes his nest on high?
28 On the cliff he dwells and makes his home,
on the point of the cliff and the stronghold.
29 From there he spies out the prey.
His eyes see it afar off.
30 His young ones also suck up blood.
Where the slain are, there he is.”

40

1 Moreover Yahweh answered Job,
2 “Shall he who argues contend with the Almighty?
He who argues with God, let him answer it.”

3 Then Job answered Yahweh,
4 “Behold, I am of small account. What will I answer you?
I lay my hand on my mouth.
5 I have spoken once, and I will not answer;
Yes, twice, but I will proceed no further.”

6 Then Yahweh answered Job out of the whirlwind:
7 “Now brace yourself like a man.
I will question you, and you will answer me.
8 Will you even annul my judgment?
Will you condemn me, that you may be justified?
9 Or do you have an arm like God?
Can you thunder with a voice like him?

10 “Now deck yourself with excellency and dignity.
Array yourself with honor and majesty.
11 Pour out the fury of your anger.
Look at everyone who is proud, and bring him low.
12 Look at everyone who is proud, and humble him.
Crush the wicked in their place.
13 Hide them in the dust together.
Bind their faces in the hidden place.
14 Then I will also admit to you
that your own right hand can save you.

15 “See now behemoth, which I made as well as you.
He eats grass as an ox.
16 Look now, his strength is in his thighs.
His force is in the muscles of his belly.
17 He moves his tail like a cedar.
The sinews of his thighs are knit together.
18 His bones are like tubes of bronze.
His limbs are like bars of iron.

19 He is the chief of the ways of God.
He who made him gives him his sword.
20 Surely the mountains produce food for him,
where all the animals of the field play.
21 He lies under the lotus trees,
in the covert of the reed, and the marsh.
22 The lotuses cover him with their shade.
The willows of the brook surround him.
23 Behold, if a river overflows, he doesn’t tremble.
He is confident, though the Jordan swells even to his mouth.
24 Shall any take him when he is on the watch,
or pierce through his nose with a snare?

41

1 “Can you draw out Leviathan† with a fish hook,
or press down his tongue with a cord?
2 Can you put a rope into his nose,
or pierce his jaw through with a hook?
3 Will he make many petitions to you,
or will he speak soft words to you?
4 Will he make a covenant with you,
that you should take him for a servant forever?
5 Will you play with him as with a bird?
Or will you bind him for your girls?
6 Will traders barter for him?
Will they part him among the merchants?
7 Can you fill his skin with barbed irons,
or his head with fish spears?
8 Lay your hand on him.
Remember the battle, and do so no more.
9 Behold, the hope of him is in vain.
Won’t one be cast down even at the sight of him?

10 None is so fierce that he dare stir him up.
Who then is he who can stand before me?
11 Who has first given to me, that I should repay him?
Everything under the heavens is mine.

12 “I will not keep silence concerning his limbs,
nor his mighty strength, nor his goodly frame.
13 Who can strip off his outer garment?
Who will come within his jaws?
14 Who can open the doors of his face?
Around his teeth is terror.
15 Strong scales are his pride,
shut up together with a close seal.

16 One is so near to another,
that no air can come between them.
17 They are joined to one another.
They stick together, so that they can’t be pulled apart.
18 His sneezing flashes out light.
His eyes are like the eyelids of the morning.
19 Out of his mouth go burning torches.
Sparks of fire leap out.
20 Out of his nostrils a smoke goes,
as of a boiling pot over a fire of reeds.
21 His breath kindles coals.
A flame goes out of his mouth.
22 There is strength in his neck.
Terror dances before him.
23 The flakes of his flesh are joined together.
They are firm on him.
They can’t be moved.
24 His heart is as firm as a stone,
yes, firm as the lower millstone.
25 When he raises himself up, the mighty are afraid.
They retreat before his thrashing.
26 If one attacks him with the sword, it can’t prevail;
nor the spear, the dart, nor the pointed shaft.
27 He counts iron as straw,
and bronze as rotten wood.
28 The arrow can’t make him flee.
Sling stones are like chaff to him.
29 Clubs are counted as stubble.
He laughs at the rushing of the javelin.
30 His undersides are like sharp potsherds,
leaving a trail in the mud like a threshing sledge.
31 He makes the deep to boil like a pot.
He makes the sea like a pot of ointment.
32 He makes a path shine after him.
One would think the deep had white hair.
33 On earth there is not his equal,
that is made without fear.
34 He sees everything that is high.
He is king over all the sons of pride.”

42

1 Then Job answered Yahweh:
2 “I know that you can do all things,
and that no purpose of yours can be restrained.

† **41:1** Leviathan is a name for a crocodile or similar creature.

3 You asked, ‘Who is this who hides
counsel without knowledge?’
therefore I have uttered that which I
didn’t understand,
things too wonderful for me, which I
didn’t know.
4 You said, ‘Listen, now, and I will speak;
I will question you, and you will
answer me.’
5 I had heard of you by the hearing of the
ear,
but now my eye sees you.
6 Therefore I abhor myself,
and repent in dust and ashes.”

7 It was so, that after Yahweh had spoken these words to Job, Yahweh said to Eliphaz the Temanite, “My wrath is kindled against you, and against your two friends; for you have not spoken of me the thing that is right, as my servant Job has.
8 Now therefore, take to yourselves seven bulls and seven rams, and go to my servant Job, and offer up for yourselves a burnt offering; and my servant Job shall pray for you, for I will accept him, that I not deal with you according to your folly. For you have not spoken of me the thing that is right, as my servant Job has.”
9 So Eliphaz the Temanite and Bildad the Shuhite and Zophar the Naamathite went and did what Yahweh commanded them, and Yahweh accepted Job.
10 Yahweh restored Job’s prosperity when he prayed for his friends. Yahweh gave Job twice as much as he had before.
11 Then all his brothers, all his sisters, and all those who had been of his acquaintance before, came to him and ate bread with him in his house. They comforted him, and consoled him concerning all the evil that Yahweh had brought on him. Everyone also gave him a piece of money,† and everyone a ring of gold.
12 So Yahweh blessed the latter end of Job more than his beginning. He had fourteen thousand sheep, six thousand camels, one thousand yoke of oxen, and a thousand female donkeys.
13 He had also seven sons and three daughters.
14 He called the name of the first, Jemimah; and the name of the second, Keziah; and the name of the third, Keren Happuch.
15 In all the land were no women found so beautiful as the daughters of Job. Their father gave them an inheritance among their brothers.
16 After this Job lived one hundred forty years, and saw his sons, and his sons’ sons, to four generations.
17 So Job died, being old and full of days.

† **42:11** literally, kesitah, a unit of money, probably silver

The Psalms
BOOK 1

1

1 Blessed is the man who doesn't walk in the counsel of the wicked,
nor stand on the path of sinners,
nor sit in the seat of scoffers;
2 but his delight is in Yahweh's† law.
On his law he meditates day and night.
3 He will be like a tree planted by the streams of water,
that produces its fruit in its season,
whose leaf also does not wither.
Whatever he does shall prosper.
4 The wicked are not so,
but are like the chaff which the wind drives away.
5 Therefore the wicked shall not stand in the judgment,
nor sinners in the congregation of the righteous.
6 For Yahweh knows the way of the righteous,
but the way of the wicked shall perish.

2

1 Why do the nations rage,
and the peoples plot a vain thing?
2 The kings of the earth take a stand,
and the rulers take counsel together,
against Yahweh, and against his Anointed,† saying,
3 "Let's break their bonds apart,
and cast their cords from us."
4 He who sits in the heavens will laugh.
The Lord‡ will have them in derision.
5 Then he will speak to them in his anger,
and terrify them in his wrath:
6 "Yet I have set my King on my holy hill of Zion."
7 I will tell of the decree:
Yahweh said to me, "You are my son.
Today I have become your father.
8 Ask of me, and I will give the nations for your inheritance,
the uttermost parts of the earth for your possession.
9 You shall break them with a rod of iron.
You shall dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel."
10 Now therefore be wise, you kings.
Be instructed, you judges of the earth.
11 Serve Yahweh with fear,
and rejoice with trembling.
12 Give sincere homage to the Son,§ lest he be angry, and you perish on the way,
for his wrath will soon be kindled.
Blessed are all those who take refuge in him.

3

A Psalm by David, when he fled from Absalom his son.
1 Yahweh, how my adversaries have increased!
Many are those who rise up against me.
2 Many there are who say of my soul,
"There is no help for him in God."†
Selah.
3 But you, Yahweh, are a shield around me,
my glory, and the one who lifts up my head.
4 I cry to Yahweh with my voice,
and he answers me out of his holy hill.
Selah.
5 I laid myself down and slept.
I awakened, for Yahweh sustains me.
6 I will not be afraid of tens of thousands of people
who have set themselves against me on every side.
7 Arise, Yahweh!
Save me, my God!
For you have struck all of my enemies on the cheek bone.
You have broken the teeth of the wicked.
8 Salvation belongs to Yahweh.
May your blessing be on your people.
Selah.

† **1:2** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. † **2:2** The word "Anointed" is the same as the word for "Messiah" or "Christ" ‡ **2:4** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." § **2:12** or, Kiss the son † **3:2** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

4

For the Chief Musician; on stringed instruments. A Psalm by David.

1 Answer me when I call, God of my righteousness.
Give me relief from my distress.
Have mercy on me, and hear my prayer.
2 You sons of men, how long shall my glory be turned into dishonor?
Will you love vanity and seek after falsehood?
Selah.
3 But know that Yahweh has set apart for himself him who is godly;
Yahweh will hear when I call to him.
4 Stand in awe, and don't sin.
Search your own heart on your bed, and be still.
Selah.
5 Offer the sacrifices of righteousness.
Put your trust in Yahweh.
6 Many say, "Who will show us any good?"
Yahweh, let the light of your face shine on us.
7 You have put gladness in my heart,
more than when their grain and their new wine are increased.
8 In peace I will both lay myself down and sleep,
for you alone, Yahweh, make me live in safety.

5

For the Chief Musician, with the flutes. A Psalm by David.

1 Give ear to my words, Yahweh.
Consider my meditation.
2 Listen to the voice of my cry, my King and my God,
for I pray to you.
3 Yahweh, in the morning you will hear my voice.
In the morning I will lay my requests before you, and will watch expectantly.
4 For you are not a God who has pleasure in wickedness.
Evil can't live with you.
5 The arrogant will not stand in your sight.
You hate all workers of iniquity.
6 You will destroy those who speak lies.
Yahweh abhors the bloodthirsty and deceitful man.
7 But as for me, in the abundance of your loving kindness I will come into your house.
I will bow toward your holy temple in reverence of you.
8 Lead me, Yahweh, in your righteousness because of my enemies.
Make your way straight before my face.
9 For there is no faithfulness in their mouth.
Their heart is destruction.
Their throat is an open tomb.
They flatter with their tongue.
10 Hold them guilty, God.
Let them fall by their own counsels.
Thrust them out in the multitude of their transgressions,
for they have rebelled against you.
11 But let all those who take refuge in you rejoice.
Let them always shout for joy, because you defend them.
Let them also who love your name be joyful in you.
12 For you will bless the righteous.
Yahweh, you will surround him with favor as with a shield.

6

For the Chief Musician; on stringed instruments, upon the eight-stringed lyre. A Psalm by David.

1 Yahweh, don't rebuke me in your anger, neither discipline me in your wrath.
2 Have mercy on me, Yahweh, for I am faint.
Yahweh, heal me, for my bones are troubled.
3 My soul is also in great anguish.
But you, Yahweh—how long?
4 Return, Yahweh. Deliver my soul,
and save me for your loving kindness' sake.
5 For in death there is no memory of you.
In Sheol,† who shall give you thanks?
6 I am weary with my groaning.
Every night I flood my bed.

† **6:5** Sheol is the place of the dead.

I drench my couch with my tears.
7 My eye wastes away because of grief.
It grows old because of all my adversaries.
8 Depart from me, all you workers of iniquity,
for Yahweh has heard the voice of my weeping.
9 Yahweh has heard my supplication.
Yahweh accepts my prayer.
10 May all my enemies be ashamed and dismayed.
They shall turn back, they shall be disgraced suddenly.

7

A meditation by David, which he sang to Yahweh, concerning the words of Cush, the Benjamite.
1 Yahweh, my God, I take refuge in you.
Save me from all those who pursue me, and deliver me,
2 lest they tear apart my soul like a lion,
ripping it in pieces, while there is no one to deliver.
3 Yahweh, my God, if I have done this,
if there is iniquity in my hands,
4 if I have rewarded evil to him who was at peace with me
(yes, I have plundered him who without cause was my adversary),
5 let the enemy pursue my soul, and overtake it;
yes, let him tread my life down to the earth,
and lay my glory in the dust.
Selah.
6 Arise, Yahweh, in your anger.
Lift up yourself against the rage of my adversaries.
Awake for me. You have commanded judgment.
7 Let the congregation of the peoples surround you.
Rule over them on high.
8 Yahweh administers judgment to the peoples.
Judge me, Yahweh, according to my righteousness,
and to my integrity that is in me.
9 Oh let the wickedness of the wicked come to an end,
but establish the righteous;
their minds and hearts are searched by the righteous God.
10 My shield is with God,
who saves the upright in heart.
11 God is a righteous judge,
yes, a God who has indignation every day.
12 If a man doesn't repent, he will sharpen his sword;
he has bent and strung his bow.
13 He has also prepared for himself the instruments of death.
He makes ready his flaming arrows.
14 Behold,† he travails with iniquity.
Yes, he has conceived mischief,
and brought out falsehood.
15 He has dug a hole,
and has fallen into the pit which he made.
16 The trouble he causes shall return to his own head.
His violence shall come down on the crown of his own head.
17 I will give thanks to Yahweh according to his righteousness,
and will sing praise to the name of Yahweh Most High.

8

For the Chief Musician; on an instrument of Gath. A Psalm by David.
1 Yahweh, our Lord, how majestic is your name in all the earth!
You have set your glory above the heavens!
2 From the lips of babes and infants you have established strength,
because of your adversaries, that you might silence the enemy and the avenger.
3 When I consider your heavens, the work of your fingers,
the moon and the stars, which you have ordained,
4 what is man, that you think of him?
What is the son of man, that you care for him?

† **7:14** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

5 For you have made him a little lower than the angels,†
and crowned him with glory and honor.
6 You make him ruler over the works of your hands.
You have put all things under his feet:
7 All sheep and cattle,
yes, and the animals of the field,
8 the birds of the sky, the fish of the sea,
and whatever passes through the paths of the seas.
9 Yahweh, our Lord,
how majestic is your name in all the earth!

9

For the Chief Musician. Set to "The Death of the Son." A Psalm by David.

1 I will give thanks to Yahweh with my whole heart.
I will tell of all your marvelous works.
2 I will be glad and rejoice in you.
I will sing praise to your name, O Most High.
3 When my enemies turn back,
they stumble and perish in your presence.
4 For you have maintained my just cause.
You sit on the throne judging righteously.
5 You have rebuked the nations.
You have destroyed the wicked.
You have blotted out their name forever and ever.
6 The enemy is overtaken by endless ruin.
The very memory of the cities which you have overthrown has perished.
7 But Yahweh reigns forever.
He has prepared his throne for judgment.
8 He will judge the world in righteousness.
He will administer judgment to the peoples in uprightness.
9 Yahweh will also be a high tower for the oppressed;
a high tower in times of trouble.
10 Those who know your name will put their trust in you,
for you, Yahweh, have not forsaken those who seek you.
11 Sing praises to Yahweh, who dwells in Zion,
and declare among the people what he has done.
12 For he who avenges blood remembers them.
He doesn't forget the cry of the afflicted.
13 Have mercy on me, Yahweh.
See my affliction by those who hate me,
and lift me up from the gates of death,
14 that I may show all of your praise.
I will rejoice in your salvation in the gates of the daughter of Zion.
15 The nations have sunk down in the pit that they made.
In the net which they hid, their own foot is taken.
16 Yahweh has made himself known.
He has executed judgment.
The wicked is snared by the work of his own hands.
Meditation. Selah.
17 The wicked shall be turned back to Sheol,†
even all the nations that forget God.
18 For the needy shall not always be forgotten,
nor the hope of the poor perish forever.
19 Arise, Yahweh! Don't let man prevail.
Let the nations be judged in your sight.
20 Put them in fear, Yahweh.
Let the nations know that they are only men.
Selah.

10

1 Why do you stand far off, Yahweh?
Why do you hide yourself in times of trouble?
2 In arrogance, the wicked hunt down the weak.

† **8:5** Hebrew: Elohim. The word Elohim, used here, usually means "God", but can also mean "gods", "princes", or "angels". The Septuagint reads "angels" here. See also the quote from the Septuagint in Hebrews 2:7. † **9:17** Sheol is the place of the dead.

They are caught in the schemes that they devise.
3 For the wicked boasts of his heart's cravings.
He blesses the greedy and condemns Yahweh.
4 The wicked, in the pride of his face,
has no room in his thoughts for God.
5 His ways are prosperous at all times.
He is arrogant, and your laws are far from his sight.
As for all his adversaries, he sneers at them.
6 He says in his heart, "I shall not be shaken.
For generations I shall have no trouble."
7 His mouth is full of cursing, deceit, and oppression.
Under his tongue is mischief and iniquity.
8 He lies in wait near the villages.
From ambushes, he murders the innocent.
His eyes are secretly set against the helpless.
9 He lurks in secret as a lion in his ambush.
He lies in wait to catch the helpless.
He catches the helpless when he draws him in his net.
10 The helpless are crushed.
They collapse.
They fall under his strength.
11 He says in his heart, "God has forgotten.
He hides his face.
He will never see it."

12 Arise, Yahweh!
God, lift up your hand!
Don't forget the helpless.
13 Why does the wicked person condemn God,
and say in his heart, "God won't call me into account"?
14 But you do see trouble and grief.
You consider it to take it into your hand.
You help the victim and the fatherless.
15 Break the arm of the wicked.
As for the evil man, seek out his wickedness until you find none.
16 Yahweh is King forever and ever!
The nations will perish out of his land.
17 Yahweh, you have heard the desire of the humble.
You will prepare their heart.
You will cause your ear to hear,
18 to judge the fatherless and the oppressed,
that man who is of the earth may terrify no more.

11

For the Chief Musician. By David.
1 In Yahweh, I take refuge.
How can you say to my soul, "Flee as a bird to your mountain"?
2 For, behold, the wicked bend their bows.
They set their arrows on the strings,
that they may shoot in darkness at the upright in heart.
3 If the foundations are destroyed,
what can the righteous do?
4 Yahweh is in his holy temple.
Yahweh is on his throne in heaven.
His eyes observe.
His eyes examine the children of men.
5 Yahweh examines the righteous,
but his soul hates the wicked and him who loves violence.
6 On the wicked he will rain blazing coals;
fire, sulfur, and scorching wind shall be the portion of their cup.
7 For Yahweh is righteous.
He loves righteousness.
The upright shall see his face.

12

For the Chief Musician; upon an eight-stringed lyre. A Psalm of David.
1 Help, Yahweh; for the godly man ceases.
For the faithful fail from among the children of men.
2 Everyone lies to his neighbor.
They speak with flattering lips, and with a double heart.
3 May Yahweh cut off all flattering lips,
and the tongue that boasts,
4 who have said, "With our tongue we will prevail.
Our lips are our own.
Who is lord over us?"
5 "Because of the oppression of the weak and because of the groaning of the needy,

I will now arise," says Yahweh;
"I will set him in safety from those who
malign him."
6 Yahweh's words are flawless words,
as silver refined in a clay furnace,
purified seven times.
7 You will keep them, Yahweh.
You will preserve them from this
generation forever.
8 The wicked walk on every side,
when what is vile is exalted among
the sons of men.

13

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 How long, Yahweh?
Will you forget me forever?
How long will you hide your face
from me?
2 How long shall I take counsel in my soul,
having sorrow in my heart every day?
How long shall my enemy triumph
over me?
3 Behold, and answer me, Yahweh, my
God.
Give light to my eyes, lest I sleep in
death;
4 lest my enemy say, "I have prevailed
against him;"
lest my adversaries rejoice when I
fall.

5 But I trust in your loving kindness.
My heart rejoices in your salvation.
6 I will sing to Yahweh,
because he has been good to me.

14

For the Chief Musician. By David.
1 The fool has said in his heart, "There is
no God."
They are corrupt.
They have done abominable deeds.
There is no one who does good.
2 Yahweh looked down from heaven on
the children of men,
to see if there were any who
understood,
who sought after God.
3 They have all gone aside.
They have together become corrupt.
There is no one who does good, no,
not one.
4 Have all the workers of iniquity no
knowledge,
who eat up my people as they eat
bread,
and don't call on Yahweh?
5 There they were in great fear,
for God is in the generation of the
righteous.
6 You frustrate the plan of the poor,
because Yahweh is his refuge.
7 Oh that the salvation of Israel would
come out of Zion!
When Yahweh restores the fortunes
of his people,
then Jacob shall rejoice, and Israel
shall be glad.

15

A Psalm by David.
1 Yahweh, who shall dwell in your
sanctuary?
Who shall live on your holy hill?
2 He who walks blamelessly and does
what is right,
and speaks truth in his heart;
3 he who doesn't slander with his tongue,
nor does evil to his friend,
nor casts slurs against his fellow man;
4 in whose eyes a vile man is despised,
but who honors those who fear
Yahweh;
he who keeps an oath even when it
hurts, and doesn't change;
5 he who doesn't lend out his money for
usury,
nor take a bribe against the innocent.

He who does these things shall never be
shaken.

16

A Poem by David.
1 Preserve me, God, for I take refuge in
you.
2 My soul, you have said to Yahweh, "You
are my Lord.
Apart from you I have no good thing."
3 As for the saints who are in the earth,
they are the excellent ones in whom
is all my delight.

4 Their sorrows shall be multiplied who
give gifts to another god.

Their drink offerings of blood I will
not offer,
nor take their names on my lips.
5 Yahweh assigned my portion and my
cup.
You made my lot secure.

6 The lines have fallen to me in pleasant
places.
Yes, I have a good inheritance.
7 I will bless Yahweh, who has given me
counsel.
Yes, my heart instructs me in the
night seasons.
8 I have set Yahweh always before me.
Because he is at my right hand, I shall
not be moved.
9 Therefore my heart is glad, and my
tongue rejoices.
My body shall also dwell in safety.
10 For you will not leave my soul in Sheol,†
neither will you allow your holy one
to see corruption.
11 You will show me the path of life.
In your presence is fullness of joy.
In your right hand there are pleasures
forever more.

17

A Prayer by David.
1 Hear, Yahweh, my righteous plea.
Give ear to my prayer that doesn't go
out of deceitful lips.
2 Let my sentence come out of your
presence.
Let your eyes look on equity.
3 You have proved my heart.
You have visited me in the night.
You have tried me, and found
nothing.
I have resolved that my mouth shall
not disobey.
4 As for the deeds of men, by the word of
your lips,
I have kept myself from the ways of
the violent.
5 My steps have held fast to your paths.
My feet have not slipped.
6 I have called on you, for you will answer
me, God.
Turn your ear to me.
Hear my speech.
7 Show your marvelous loving kindness,
you who save those who take refuge
by your right hand from their
enemies.
8 Keep me as the apple of your eye.
Hide me under the shadow of your
wings,
9 from the wicked who oppress me,
my deadly enemies, who surround
me.
10 They close up their callous hearts.
With their mouth they speak proudly.
11 They have now surrounded us in our
steps.
They set their eyes to cast us down to
the earth.
12 He is like a lion that is greedy of his
prey,
as it were a young lion lurking in
secret places.
13 Arise, Yahweh, confront him.
Cast him down.
Deliver my soul from the wicked by your
sword,
14 from men by your hand, Yahweh,
from men of the world, whose
portion is in this life.
You fill the belly of your cherished ones.
Your sons have plenty,
and they store up wealth for their
children.
15 As for me, I shall see your face in
righteousness.
I shall be satisfied, when I awake,
with seeing your form.

18

For the Chief Musician. By David the
servant of Yahweh, who spoke to Yahweh
the words of this song in the day that
Yahweh delivered him from the hand of
all his enemies, and from the hand of
Saul. He said,
1 I love you, Yahweh, my strength.
2 Yahweh is my rock, my fortress, and my
deliverer;
my God, my rock, in whom I take
refuge;
my shield, and the horn of my
salvation, my high tower.

† **16:10** Sheol is the place of the dead.

3 I call on Yahweh, who is worthy to be
praised;
and I am saved from my enemies.
4 The cords of death surrounded me.
The floods of ungodliness made me
afraid.
5 The cords of Sheol† were around me.
The snares of death came on me.
6 In my distress I called on Yahweh,
and cried to my God.
He heard my voice out of his temple.
My cry before him came into his ears.
7 Then the earth shook and trembled.
The foundations also of the
mountains quaked and were
shaken,
because he was angry.
8 Smoke went out of his nostrils.
Consuming fire came out of his
mouth.
Coals were kindled by it.
9 He bowed the heavens also, and came
down.
Thick darkness was under his feet.
10 He rode on a cherub, and flew.
Yes, he soared on the wings of the
wind.
11 He made darkness his hiding place, his
pavilion around him,
darkness of waters, thick clouds of
the skies.
12 At the brightness before him his thick
clouds passed,
hailstones and coals of fire.
13 Yahweh also thundered in the sky.
The Most High uttered his voice:
hailstones and coals of fire.
14 He sent out his arrows, and scattered
them.
He routed them with great lightning
bolts.
15 Then the channels of waters appeared.
The foundations of the world were
laid bare at your rebuke, Yahweh,
at the blast of the breath of your
nostrils.
16 He sent from on high.
He took me.
He drew me out of many waters.
17 He delivered me from my strong enemy,
from those who hated me; for they
were too mighty for me.
18 They came on me in the day of my
calamity,
but Yahweh was my support.
19 He brought me out also into a large
place.
He delivered me, because he
delighted in me.
20 Yahweh has rewarded me according to
my righteousness.
According to the cleanness of my
hands, he has recompensed me.
21 For I have kept the ways of Yahweh,
and have not wickedly departed from
my God.
22 For all his ordinances were before me.
I didn't put away his statutes from me.
23 I was also blameless with him.
I kept myself from my iniquity.
24 Therefore Yahweh has rewarded me
according to my righteousness,
according to the cleanness of my
hands in his eyesight.
25 With the merciful you will show
yourself merciful.
With the perfect man, you will show
yourself perfect.
26 With the pure, you will show yourself
pure.
With the crooked you will show
yourself shrewd.
27 For you will save the afflicted people,
but the arrogant eyes you will bring
down.
28 For you will light my lamp, Yahweh.
My God will light up my darkness.
29 For by you, I advance through a troop.
By my God, I leap over a wall.
30 As for God, his way is perfect.
Yahweh's word is tried.
He is a shield to all those who take
refuge in him.
31 For who is God, except Yahweh?
Who is a rock, besides our God,
32 the God who arms me with
strength, and makes my way
perfect?
33 He makes my feet like deer's feet,
and sets me on my high places.
34 He teaches my hands to war,

† **18:5** Sheol is the place of the dead.

so that my arms bend a bow of
bronze.
35 You have also given me the shield of
your salvation.
Your right hand sustains me.
Your gentleness has made me great.
36 You have enlarged my steps under me,
My feet have not slipped.
37 I will pursue my enemies, and overtake
them.
I won't turn away until they are
consumed.
38 I will strike them through, so that they
will not be able to rise.
They shall fall under my feet.
39 For you have armed me with strength to
the battle.
You have subdued under me those
who rose up against me.
40 You have also made my enemies turn
their backs to me,
that I might cut off those who hate me.
41 They cried, but there was no one to
save;
even to Yahweh, but he didn't answer
them.
42 Then I beat them small as the dust
before the wind.
I cast them out as the mire of the
streets.
43 You have delivered me from the
strivings of the people.
You have made me the head of the
nations.
A people whom I have not known shall
serve me.
44 As soon as they hear of me they
shall obey me.
The foreigners shall submit
themselves to me.
45 The foreigners shall fade away,
and shall come trembling out of their
strongholds.
46 Yahweh lives! Blessed be my rock.
Exalted be the God of my salvation,
47 even the God who executes vengeance
for me,
and subdues peoples under me.
48 He rescues me from my enemies.
Yes, you lift me up above those who
rise up against me.
You deliver me from the violent man.
49 Therefore I will give thanks to you,
Yahweh, among the nations,
and will sing praises to your name.
50 He gives great deliverance to his king,
and shows loving kindness to his
anointed,
to David and to his offspring,‡ forever
more.

19

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 The heavens declare the glory of God.
The expanse shows his handiwork.
2 Day after day they pour out speech,
and night after night they display
knowledge.
3 There is no speech nor language
where their voice is not heard.
4 Their voice has gone out through all the
earth,
their words to the end of the world.
In them he has set a tent for the sun,
5 which is as a bridegroom coming out
of his room,
like a strong man rejoicing to run his
course.
6 His going out is from the end of the
heavens,
his circuit to its ends.
There is nothing hidden from its heat.

7 Yahweh's law is perfect, restoring the
soul.
Yahweh's covenant is sure, making
wise the simple.
8 Yahweh's precepts are right, rejoicing
the heart.
Yahweh's commandment is pure,
enlightening the eyes.
9 The fear of Yahweh is clean, enduring
forever.
Yahweh's ordinances are true, and
righteous altogether.
10 They are more to be desired than gold,
yes, than much fine gold,
sweeter also than honey and the
extract of the honeycomb.
11 Moreover your servant is warned by
them.
In keeping them there is great
reward.
12 Who can discern his errors?

‡ **18:50** or, seed

Forgive me from hidden errors.

13 Keep back your servant also from
presumptuous sins.
Let them not have dominion over me.
Then I will be upright.
I will be blameless and innocent of
great transgression.
14 Let the words of my mouth and the
meditation of my heart
be acceptable in your sight,
Yahweh, my rock, and my redeemer.

20

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 May Yahweh answer you in the day of
trouble.
May the name of the God of Jacob set
you up on high,
2 send you help from the sanctuary,
grant you support from Zion,
3 remember all your offerings,
and accept your burned sacrifice.
Selah.
4 May he grant you your heart's desire,
and fulfill all your counsel.
5 We will triumph in your salvation.
In the name of our God, we will set up
our banners.
May Yahweh grant all your requests.
6 Now I know that Yahweh saves his
anointed.
He will answer him from his holy
heaven,
with the saving strength of his right
hand.
7 Some trust in chariots, and some in
horses,
but we trust in the name of Yahweh
our God.
8 They are bowed down and fallen,
but we rise up, and stand upright.
9 Save, Yahweh!
Let the King answer us when we call!

21

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 The king rejoices in your strength,
Yahweh!
How greatly he rejoices in your
salvation!
2 You have given him his heart's desire,
and have not withheld the request of
his lips.
Selah.
3 For you meet him with the blessings of
goodness.
You set a crown of fine gold on his
head.
4 He asked life of you and you gave it to
him,
even length of days forever and ever.
5 His glory is great in your salvation.
You lay honor and majesty on him.
6 For you make him most blessed forever.
You make him glad with joy in your
presence.
7 For the king trusts in Yahweh.
Through the loving kindness of the
Most High, he shall not be moved.
8 Your hand will find out all of your
enemies.
Your right hand will find out those
who hate you.
9 You will make them as a fiery furnace in
the time of your anger.
Yahweh will swallow them up in his
wrath.
The fire shall devour them.
10 You will destroy their descendants from
the earth,
their posterity from among the
children of men.
11 For they intended evil against you.
They plotted evil against you which
cannot succeed.
12 For you will make them turn their back,
when you aim drawn bows at their
face.
13 Be exalted, Yahweh, in your strength,
so we will sing and praise your power.

22

For the Chief Musician; set to "The Doe of the Morning." A Psalm by David.
1 My God, my God, why have you forsaken
me?
Why are you so far from helping me,
and from the words of my
groaning?
2 My God, I cry in the daytime, but you
don't answer;
in the night season, and am not silent.
3 But you are holy,

you who inhabit the praises of Israel.
4 Our fathers trusted in you.
They trusted, and you delivered them.
5 They cried to you, and were delivered.
They trusted in you, and were not disappointed.
6 But I am a worm, and no man;
a reproach of men, and despised by the people.
7 All those who see me mock me.
They insult me with their lips. They shake their heads, saying,
8 "He trusts in Yahweh.
Let him deliver him.
Let him rescue him, since he delights in him."
9 But you brought me out of the womb.
You made me trust while at my mother's breasts.
10 I was thrown on you from my mother's womb.
You are my God since my mother bore me.
11 Don't be far from me, for trouble is near.
For there is no one to help.
12 Many bulls have surrounded me.
Strong bulls of Bashan have encircled me.
13 They open their mouths wide against me,
lions tearing prey and roaring.
14 I am poured out like water.
All my bones are out of joint.
My heart is like wax.
It is melted within me.
15 My strength is dried up like a potsherd.
My tongue sticks to the roof of my mouth.
You have brought me into the dust of death.
16 For dogs have surrounded me.
A company of evildoers have enclosed me.
They have pierced my hands and feet.†
17 I can count all of my bones.
They look and stare at me.
18 They divide my garments among them.
They cast lots for my clothing.

19 But don't be far off, Yahweh.
You are my help. Hurry to help me!
20 Deliver my soul from the sword,
my precious life from the power of the dog.
21 Save me from the lion's mouth!
Yes, you have rescued me from the horns of the wild oxen.

22 I will declare your name to my brothers.
Among the assembly, I will praise you.
23 You who fear Yahweh, praise him!
All you descendants of Jacob, glorify him!
Stand in awe of him, all you descendants of Israel!
24 For he has not despised nor abhorred the affliction of the afflicted,
neither has he hidden his face from him;
but when he cried to him, he heard.

25 My praise of you comes in the great assembly.
I will pay my vows before those who fear him.
26 The humble shall eat and be satisfied.
They shall praise Yahweh who seek after him.
Let your hearts live forever.
27 All the ends of the earth shall remember and turn to Yahweh.
All the relatives of the nations shall worship before you.
28 For the kingdom is Yahweh's.
He is the ruler over the nations.
29 All the rich ones of the earth shall eat and worship.
All those who go down to the dust shall bow before him,
even he who can't keep his soul alive.
30 Posterity shall serve him.
Future generations shall be told about the Lord.
31 They shall come and shall declare his righteousness to a people that shall be born,
for he has done it.

23

A Psalm by David.
1 Yahweh is my shepherd;
I shall lack nothing.

† **22:16** So Dead Sea Scrolls. Masoretic Text reads, "Like a lion, they pin my hands and feet."

2 He makes me lie down in green pastures.
He leads me beside still waters.
3 He restores my soul.
He guides me in the paths of
righteousness for his name's sake.
4 Even though I walk through the valley of
the shadow of death,
I will fear no evil, for you are with me.
Your rod and your staff,
they comfort me.
5 You prepare a table before me
in the presence of my enemies.
You anoint my head with oil.
My cup runs over.
6 Surely goodness and loving kindness
shall follow me all the days of my
life,
and I will dwell in Yahweh's house
forever.

24

A Psalm by David.
1 The earth is Yahweh's, with its fullness;
the world, and those who dwell in it.
2 For he has founded it on the seas,
and established it on the floods.

3 Who may ascend to Yahweh's hill?
Who may stand in his holy place?
4 He who has clean hands and a pure
heart;
who has not lifted up his soul to
falsehood,
and has not sworn deceitfully.
5 He shall receive a blessing from Yahweh,
righteousness from the God of his
salvation.
6 This is the generation of those who seek
Him,
who seek your face—even Jacob.
Selah.

7 Lift up your heads, you gates!
Be lifted up, you everlasting doors,
and the King of glory will come in.
8 Who is the King of glory?
Yahweh strong and mighty,
Yahweh mighty in battle.
9 Lift up your heads, you gates;
yes, lift them up, you everlasting
doors,
and the King of glory will come in.
10 Who is this King of glory?
Yahweh of Armies is the King of glory!
Selah.

25

By David.
1 To you, Yahweh, I lift up my soul.
2 My God, I have trusted in you.
Don't let me be shamed.
Don't let my enemies triumph over
me.
3 Yes, no one who waits for you will be
shamed.
They will be shamed who deal
treacherously without cause.

4 Show me your ways, Yahweh.
Teach me your paths.
5 Guide me in your truth, and teach me,
for you are the God of my salvation.
I wait for you all day long.
6 Yahweh, remember your tender mercies
and your loving kindness,
for they are from old times.
7 Don't remember the sins of my youth,
nor my transgressions.
Remember me according to your
loving kindness,
for your goodness' sake, Yahweh.
8 Good and upright is Yahweh,
therefore he will instruct sinners in
the way.
9 He will guide the humble in justice.
He will teach the humble his way.
10 All the paths of Yahweh are loving
kindness and truth
to such as keep his covenant and his
testimonies.
11 For your name's sake, Yahweh,
pardon my iniquity, for it is great.
12 What man is he who fears Yahweh?
He shall instruct him in the way that
he shall choose.
13 His soul will dwell at ease.
His offspring will inherit the land.
14 The friendship of Yahweh is with those
who fear him.
He will show them his covenant.

15 My eyes are ever on Yahweh,
for he will pluck my feet out of the net.
16 Turn to me, and have mercy on me,
for I am desolate and afflicted.

17 The troubles of my heart are enlarged.
Oh bring me out of my distresses.
18 Consider my affliction and my travail.
Forgive all my sins.
19 Consider my enemies, for they are many.
They hate me with cruel hatred.
20 Oh keep my soul, and deliver me.
Let me not be disappointed, for I take refuge in you.
21 Let integrity and uprightness preserve me,
for I wait for you.
22 God, redeem Israel
out of all his troubles.

26

By David.
1 Judge me, Yahweh, for I have walked in my integrity.
I have trusted also in Yahweh without wavering.
2 Examine me, Yahweh, and prove me.
Try my heart and my mind.
3 For your loving kindness is before my eyes.
I have walked in your truth.
4 I have not sat with deceitful men,
neither will I go in with hypocrites.
5 I hate the assembly of evildoers,
and will not sit with the wicked.
6 I will wash my hands in innocence,
so I will go about your altar, Yahweh,
7 that I may make the voice of thanksgiving to be heard
and tell of all your wondrous deeds.
8 Yahweh, I love the habitation of your house,
the place where your glory dwells.
9 Don't gather my soul with sinners,
nor my life with bloodthirsty men
10 in whose hands is wickedness;
their right hand is full of bribes.

11 But as for me, I will walk in my integrity.
Redeem me, and be merciful to me.
12 My foot stands in an even place.
In the congregations I will bless Yahweh.

27

By David.
1 Yahweh is my light and my salvation.
Whom shall I fear?
Yahweh is the strength of my life.
Of whom shall I be afraid?
2 When evildoers came at me to eat up my flesh,
even my adversaries and my foes,
they stumbled and fell.
3 Though an army should encamp against me,
my heart shall not fear.
Though war should rise against me,
even then I will be confident.
4 One thing I have asked of Yahweh, that I will seek after:
that I may dwell in Yahweh's house all the days of my life,
to see Yahweh's beauty,
and to inquire in his temple.
5 For in the day of trouble, he will keep me secretly in his pavilion.
In the secret place of his tabernacle, he will hide me.
He will lift me up on a rock.
6 Now my head will be lifted up above my enemies around me.
I will offer sacrifices of joy in his tent.
I will sing, yes, I will sing praises to Yahweh.

7 Hear, Yahweh, when I cry with my voice.
Have mercy also on me, and answer me.
8 When you said, "Seek my face,"
my heart said to you, "I will seek your face, Yahweh."
9 Don't hide your face from me.
Don't put your servant away in anger.
You have been my help.
Don't abandon me,
neither forsake me, God of my salvation.
10 When my father and my mother forsake me,
then Yahweh will take me up.
11 Teach me your way, Yahweh.
Lead me in a straight path, because of my enemies.
12 Don't deliver me over to the desire of my adversaries,
for false witnesses have risen up against me,
such as breathe out cruelty.

13 I am still confident of this:
I will see the goodness of Yahweh in the land of the living.
14 Wait for Yahweh.
Be strong, and let your heart take courage.
Yes, wait for Yahweh.

28

By David.
1 To you, Yahweh, I call.
My rock, don't be deaf to me,
lest, if you are silent to me,
I would become like those who go down into the pit.
2 Hear the voice of my petitions, when I cry to you,
when I lift up my hands toward your Most Holy Place.
3 Don't draw me away with the wicked,
with the workers of iniquity who speak peace with their neighbors,
but mischief is in their hearts.
4 Give them according to their work, and according to the wickedness of their doings.
Give them according to the operation of their hands.
Bring back on them what they deserve.
5 Because they don't respect the works of Yahweh,
nor the operation of his hands,
he will break them down and not build them up.

6 Blessed be Yahweh,
because he has heard the voice of my petitions.
7 Yahweh is my strength and my shield.
My heart has trusted in him, and I am helped.
Therefore my heart greatly rejoices.
With my song I will thank him.
8 Yahweh is their strength.
He is a stronghold of salvation to his anointed.
9 Save your people,
and bless your inheritance.
Be their shepherd also,
and bear them up forever.

29

A Psalm by David.
1 Ascribe to Yahweh, you sons of the mighty,
ascribe to Yahweh glory and strength.
2 Ascribe to Yahweh the glory due to his name.
Worship Yahweh in holy array.

3 Yahweh's voice is on the waters.
The God of glory thunders, even Yahweh on many waters.
4 Yahweh's voice is powerful.
Yahweh's voice is full of majesty.
5 Yahweh's voice breaks the cedars.
Yes, Yahweh breaks in pieces the cedars of Lebanon.
6 He makes them also to skip like a calf;
Lebanon and Sirion like a young, wild ox.
7 Yahweh's voice strikes with flashes of lightning.
8 Yahweh's voice shakes the wilderness.
Yahweh shakes the wilderness of Kadesh.
9 Yahweh's voice makes the deer calve,
and strips the forests bare.
In his temple everything says, "Glory!"

10 Yahweh sat enthroned at the Flood.
Yes, Yahweh sits as King forever.
11 Yahweh will give strength to his people.
Yahweh will bless his people with peace.

30

A Psalm. A Song for the Dedication of the Temple. By David.
1 I will extol you, Yahweh, for you have raised me up,
and have not made my foes to rejoice over me.
2 Yahweh my God, I cried to you,
and you have healed me.
3 Yahweh, you have brought up my soul from Sheol.†
You have kept me alive, that I should not go down to the pit.
4 Sing praise to Yahweh, you saints of his.
Give thanks to his holy name.
5 For his anger is but for a moment.

† **30:3** Sheol is the place of the dead.

His favor is for a lifetime.
Weeping may stay for the night,
but joy comes in the morning.
6 As for me, I said in my prosperity,
"I shall never be moved."
7 You, Yahweh, when you favored me,
made my mountain stand strong;
but when you hid your face, I was troubled.
8 I cried to you, Yahweh.
I made supplication to the Lord:
9 "What profit is there in my destruction,
if I go down to the pit?
Shall the dust praise you?
Shall it declare your truth?
10 Hear, Yahweh, and have mercy on me.
Yahweh, be my helper."
11 You have turned my mourning into dancing for me.
You have removed my sackcloth, and clothed me with gladness,
12 to the end that my heart may sing praise to you, and not be silent.
Yahweh my God, I will give thanks to you forever!

31

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 In you, Yahweh, I take refuge.
Let me never be disappointed.
Deliver me in your righteousness.
2 Bow down your ear to me.
Deliver me speedily.
Be to me a strong rock,
a house of defense to save me.
3 For you are my rock and my fortress,
therefore for your name's sake lead me and guide me.
4 Pluck me out of the net that they have laid secretly for me,
for you are my stronghold.
5 Into your hand I commend my spirit.
You redeem me, Yahweh, God of truth.
6 I hate those who regard lying vanities,
but I trust in Yahweh.
7 I will be glad and rejoice in your loving kindness,
for you have seen my affliction.
You have known my soul in adversities.
8 You have not shut me up into the hand of the enemy.
You have set my feet in a large place.
9 Have mercy on me, Yahweh, for I am in distress.
My eye, my soul, and my body waste away with grief.
10 For my life is spent with sorrow,
my years with sighing.
My strength fails because of my iniquity.
My bones are wasted away.
11 Because of all my adversaries I have become utterly contemptible to my neighbors,
a horror to my acquaintances.
Those who saw me on the street fled from me.
12 I am forgotten from their hearts like a dead man.
I am like broken pottery.
13 For I have heard the slander of many,
terror on every side,
while they conspire together against me,
they plot to take away my life.
14 But I trust in you, Yahweh.
I said, "You are my God."
15 My times are in your hand.
Deliver me from the hand of my enemies, and from those who persecute me.
16 Make your face to shine on your servant.
Save me in your loving kindness.
17 Let me not be disappointed, Yahweh,
for I have called on you.
Let the wicked be disappointed.
Let them be silent in Sheol.†
18 Let the lying lips be mute,
which speak against the righteous insolently, with pride and contempt.
19 Oh how great is your goodness,
which you have laid up for those who fear you,
which you have worked for those who take refuge in you,
before the sons of men!
20 In the shelter of your presence you will hide them from the plotting of man.

† **31:17** Sheol is the place of the dead.

You will keep them secretly in a
dwelling away from the strife of
tongues.
21 Praise be to Yahweh,
for he has shown me his marvelous
loving kindness in a strong city.
22 As for me, I said in my haste, “I am cut
off from before your eyes.”
Nevertheless you heard the voice of
my petitions when I cried to you.
23 Oh love Yahweh, all you his saints!
Yahweh preserves the faithful,
and fully recompenses him who behaves
arrogantly.
24 Be strong, and let your heart take
courage,
all you who hope in Yahweh.

32

By David. A contemplative psalm.
1 Blessed is he whose disobedience is
forgiven,
whose sin is covered.
2 Blessed is the man to whom Yahweh
doesn’t impute iniquity,
in whose spirit there is no deceit.
3 When I kept silence, my bones wasted
away through my groaning all day
long.
4 For day and night your hand was heavy
on me.
My strength was sapped in the heat of
summer.
Selah.
5 I acknowledged my sin to you.
I didn’t hide my iniquity.
I said, I will confess my transgressions to
Yahweh,
and you forgave the iniquity of my
sin.
Selah.
6 For this, let everyone who is godly pray
to you in a time when you may be
found.
Surely when the great waters
overflow, they shall not reach to
him.
7 You are my hiding place.
You will preserve me from trouble.
You will surround me with songs of
deliverance.
Selah.
8 I will instruct you and teach you in the
way which you shall go.
I will counsel you with my eye on you.
9 Don’t be like the horse, or like the mule,
which have no understanding,
who are controlled by bit and bridle,
or else they will not come near to
you.
10 Many sorrows come to the wicked,
but loving kindness shall surround
him who trusts in Yahweh.
11 Be glad in Yahweh, and rejoice, you
righteous!
Shout for joy, all you who are upright
in heart!

33

1 Rejoice in Yahweh, you righteous!
Praise is fitting for the upright.
2 Give thanks to Yahweh with the lyre.
Sing praises to him with the harp of
ten strings.
3 Sing to him a new song.
Play skillfully with a shout of joy!
4 For Yahweh’s word is right.
All his work is done in faithfulness.
5 He loves righteousness and justice.
The earth is full of the loving
kindness of Yahweh.
6 By Yahweh’s word, the heavens were
made:
all their army by the breath of his
mouth.
7 He gathers the waters of the sea together
as a heap.
He lays up the deeps in storehouses.
8 Let all the earth fear Yahweh.
Let all the inhabitants of the world
stand in awe of him.
9 For he spoke, and it was done.
He commanded, and it stood firm.
10 Yahweh brings the counsel of the
nations to nothing.
He makes the thoughts of the peoples
to be of no effect.
11 The counsel of Yahweh stands fast
forever,
the thoughts of his heart to all
generations.
12 Blessed is the nation whose God is
Yahweh,
the people whom he has chosen for
his own inheritance.

13 Yahweh looks from heaven.
He sees all the sons of men.
14 From the place of his habitation he
looks out on all the inhabitants of
the earth,
15 he who fashions all of their hearts;
and he considers all of their works.
16 There is no king saved by the multitude
of an army.
A mighty man is not delivered by
great strength.
17 A horse is a vain thing for safety,
neither does he deliver any by his
great power.
18 Behold, Yahweh's eye is on those who
fear him,
on those who hope in his loving
kindness,
19 to deliver their soul from death,
to keep them alive in famine.
20 Our soul has waited for Yahweh.
He is our help and our shield.
21 For our heart rejoices in him,
because we have trusted in his holy
name.
22 Let your loving kindness be on us,
Yahweh,
since we have hoped in you.

34

By David; when he pretended to be insane before Abimelech, who drove him away, and he departed.

1 †I will bless Yahweh at all times.
His praise will always be in my
mouth.
2 My soul shall boast in Yahweh.
The humble shall hear of it and be
glad.
3 Oh magnify Yahweh with me.
Let's exalt his name together.
4 I sought Yahweh, and he answered me,
and delivered me from all my fears.
5 They looked to him, and were radiant.
Their faces shall never be covered
with shame.
6 This poor man cried, and Yahweh heard
him,
and saved him out of all his troubles.
7 Yahweh's angel encamps around those
who fear him,
and delivers them.
8 Oh taste and see that Yahweh is good.
Blessed is the man who takes refuge
in him.
9 Oh fear Yahweh, you his saints,
for there is no lack with those who
fear him.
10 The young lions do lack, and suffer
hunger,
but those who seek Yahweh shall not
lack any good thing.

11 Come, you children, listen to me.
I will teach you the fear of Yahweh.
12 Who is someone who desires life,
and loves many days, that he may see
good?
13 Keep your tongue from evil,
and your lips from speaking lies.
14 Depart from evil, and do good.
Seek peace, and pursue it.
15 Yahweh's eyes are toward the righteous.
His ears listen to their cry.
16 Yahweh's face is against those who do
evil,
to cut off their memory from the
earth.
17 The righteous cry, and Yahweh hears,
and delivers them out of all their
troubles.
18 Yahweh is near to those who have a
broken heart,
and saves those who have a crushed
spirit.
19 Many are the afflictions of the
righteous,
but Yahweh delivers him out of them
all.
20 He protects all of his bones.
Not one of them is broken.
21 Evil shall kill the wicked.
Those who hate the righteous shall be
condemned.
22 Yahweh redeems the soul of his
servants.
None of those who take refuge in him
shall be condemned.

35

By David.

1 Contend, Yahweh, with those who
contend with me.

† **34:1** Psalm 34 is an acrostic poem, with each verse starting with a letter of the alphabet (ordered from Alef to Tav).

Fight against those who fight against me.
2 Take hold of shield and buckler,
and stand up for my help.
3 Brandish the spear and block those who pursue me.
Tell my soul, “I am your salvation.”
4 Let those who seek after my soul be disappointed and brought to dishonor.
Let those who plot my ruin be turned back and confounded.
5 Let them be as chaff before the wind,
Yahweh’s angel driving them on.
6 Let their way be dark and slippery,
Yahweh’s angel pursuing them.
7 For without cause they have hidden their net in a pit for me.
Without cause they have dug a pit for my soul.
8 Let destruction come on him unawares.
Let his net that he has hidden catch himself.
Let him fall into that destruction.

9 My soul shall be joyful in Yahweh.
It shall rejoice in his salvation.
10 All my bones shall say, “Yahweh, who is like you,
who delivers the poor from him who is too strong for him;
yes, the poor and the needy from him who robs him?”
11 Unrighteous witnesses rise up.
They ask me about things that I don’t know about.
12 They reward me evil for good,
to the bereaving of my soul.

13 But as for me, when they were sick, my clothing was sackcloth.
I afflicted my soul with fasting.
My prayer returned into my own bosom.
14 I behaved myself as though it had been my friend or my brother.
I bowed down mourning, as one who mourns his mother.
15 But in my adversity, they rejoiced, and gathered themselves together.
The attackers gathered themselves together against me, and I didn’t know it.
They tore at me, and didn’t cease.
16 Like the profane mockers in feasts,
they gnashed their teeth at me.
17 Lord, how long will you look on?
Rescue my soul from their destruction,
my precious life from the lions.
18 I will give you thanks in the great assembly.
I will praise you among many people.
19 Don’t let those who are my enemies wrongfully rejoice over me;
neither let those who hate me without a cause wink their eyes.
20 For they don’t speak peace,
but they devise deceitful words against those who are quiet in the land.
21 Yes, they opened their mouth wide against me.
They said, “Aha! Aha! Our eye has seen it!”
22 You have seen it, Yahweh. Don’t keep silent.
Lord, don’t be far from me.
23 Wake up! Rise up to defend me, my God!
My Lord, contend for me!
24 Vindicate me, Yahweh my God, according to your righteousness.
Don’t let them gloat over me.
25 Don’t let them say in their heart, “Aha! That’s the way we want it!”
Don’t let them say, “We have swallowed him up!”
26 Let them be disappointed and confounded together who rejoice at my calamity.
Let them be clothed with shame and dishonor who magnify themselves against me.

27 Let those who favor my righteous cause shout for joy and be glad.
Yes, let them say continually, “May Yahweh be magnified,
who has pleasure in the prosperity of his servant!”
28 My tongue shall talk about your righteousness and about your praise all day long.

36

For the Chief Musician. By David, the servant of Yahweh.

1 A revelation is within my heart about the disobedience of the wicked:
There is no fear of God before his eyes.
2 For he flatters himself in his own eyes,
too much to detect and hate his sin.
3 The words of his mouth are iniquity and deceit.
He has ceased to be wise and to do good.
4 He plots iniquity on his bed.
He sets himself in a way that is not good.
He doesn't abhor evil.

5 Your loving kindness, Yahweh, is in the heavens.
Your faithfulness reaches to the skies.
6 Your righteousness is like the mountains of God.
Your judgments are like a great deep.
Yahweh, you preserve man and animal.
7 How precious is your loving kindness, God!
The children of men take refuge under the shadow of your wings.
8 They shall be abundantly satisfied with the abundance of your house.
You will make them drink of the river of your pleasures.
9 For with you is the spring of life.
In your light we will see light.
10 Oh continue your loving kindness to those who know you,
your righteousness to the upright in heart.
11 Don't let the foot of pride come against me.
Don't let the hand of the wicked drive me away.
12 There the workers of iniquity are fallen.
They are thrust down, and shall not be able to rise.

37

By David.

1 Don't fret because of evildoers,
neither be envious against those who work unrighteousness.
2 For they shall soon be cut down like the grass,
and wither like the green herb.
3 Trust in Yahweh, and do good.
Dwell in the land, and enjoy safe pasture.
4 Also delight yourself in Yahweh,
and he will give you the desires of your heart.
5 Commit your way to Yahweh.
Trust also in him, and he will do this:
6 he will make your righteousness shine out like light,
and your justice as the noon day sun.
7 Rest in Yahweh, and wait patiently for him.
Don't fret because of him who prospers in his way,
because of the man who makes wicked plots happen.
8 Cease from anger, and forsake wrath.
Don't fret; it leads only to evildoing.
9 For evildoers shall be cut off,
but those who wait for Yahweh shall inherit the land.
10 For yet a little while, and the wicked will be no more.
Yes, though you look for his place, he isn't there.
11 But the humble shall inherit the land,
and shall delight themselves in the abundance of peace.
12 The wicked plots against the just,
and gnashes at him with his teeth.
13 The Lord will laugh at him,
for he sees that his day is coming.
14 The wicked have drawn out the sword, and have bent their bow,
to cast down the poor and needy,
to kill those who are upright on the path.
15 Their sword shall enter into their own heart.
Their bows shall be broken.
16 Better is a little that the righteous has,
than the abundance of many wicked.
17 For the arms of the wicked shall be broken,
but Yahweh upholds the righteous.
18 Yahweh knows the days of the perfect.
Their inheritance shall be forever.
19 They shall not be disappointed in the time of evil.

In the days of famine they shall be satisfied.

20 But the wicked shall perish.
The enemies of Yahweh shall be like the beauty of the fields.
They will vanish—
vanish like smoke.
21 The wicked borrow, and don't pay back,
but the righteous give generously.
22 For such as are blessed by him shall inherit the land.
Those who are cursed by him shall be cut off.
23 A man's steps are established by Yahweh.
He delights in his way.
24 Though he stumble, he shall not fall,
for Yahweh holds him up with his hand.
25 I have been young, and now am old,
yet I have not seen the righteous forsaken,
nor his children begging for bread.
26 All day long he deals graciously, and lends.
His offspring is blessed.
27 Depart from evil, and do good.
Live securely forever.
28 For Yahweh loves justice,
and doesn't forsake his saints.
They are preserved forever,
but the children of the wicked shall be cut off.
29 The righteous shall inherit the land,
and live in it forever.

30 The mouth of the righteous talks of wisdom.
His tongue speaks justice.
31 The law of his God is in his heart.
None of his steps shall slide.
32 The wicked watch the righteous,
and seek to kill him.
33 Yahweh will not leave him in his hand,
nor condemn him when he is judged.
34 Wait for Yahweh, and keep his way,
and he will exalt you to inherit the land.
When the wicked are cut off, you shall see it.

35 I have seen the wicked in great power,
spreading himself like a green tree in its native soil.
36 But he passed away, and behold, he was not.
Yes, I sought him, but he could not be found.
37 Mark the perfect man, and see the upright,
for there is a future for the man of peace.
38 As for transgressors, they shall be destroyed together.
The future of the wicked shall be cut off.
39 But the salvation of the righteous is from Yahweh.
He is their stronghold in the time of trouble.
40 Yahweh helps them and rescues them.
He rescues them from the wicked and saves them,
because they have taken refuge in him.

38

A Psalm by David, for a memorial.
1 Yahweh, don't rebuke me in your wrath,
neither chasten me in your hot displeasure.
2 For your arrows have pierced me,
your hand presses hard on me.
3 There is no soundness in my flesh because of your indignation,
neither is there any health in my bones because of my sin.
4 For my iniquities have gone over my head.
As a heavy burden, they are too heavy for me.
5 My wounds are loathsome and corrupt because of my foolishness.
6 I am in pain and bowed down greatly.
I go mourning all day long.
7 For my waist is filled with burning.
There is no soundness in my flesh.
8 I am faint and severely bruised.
I have groaned by reason of the anguish of my heart.
9 Lord, all my desire is before you.
My groaning is not hidden from you.
10 My heart throbs.
My strength fails me.

As for the light of my eyes, it has also
left me.
11 My lovers and my friends stand aloof
from my plague.
My kinsmen stand far away.
12 They also who seek after my life lay
snares.
Those who seek my hurt speak
mischievous things,
and meditate deceits all day long.
13 But I, as a deaf man, don't hear.
I am as a mute man who doesn't open
his mouth.
14 Yes, I am as a man who doesn't hear,
in whose mouth are no reproofs.
15 For I hope in you, Yahweh.
You will answer, Lord my God.
16 For I said, "Don't let them gloat over me,
or exalt themselves over me when my
foot slips."
17 For I am ready to fall.
My pain is continually before me.
18 For I will declare my iniquity.
I will be sorry for my sin.
19 But my enemies are vigorous and many.
Those who hate me without reason
are numerous.
20 They who give evil for good are also
adversaries to me,
because I follow what is good.
21 Don't forsake me, Yahweh.
My God, don't be far from me.
22 Hurry to help me,
Lord, my salvation.

39

For the Chief Musician. For Jeduthun. A
Psalm by David.
1 I said, "I will watch my ways, so that I
don't sin with my tongue.
I will keep my mouth with a bridle
while the wicked is before me."
2 I was mute with silence.
I held my peace, even from good.
My sorrow was stirred.
3 My heart was hot within me.
While I meditated, the fire burned.
I spoke with my tongue:
4 "Yahweh, show me my end,
what is the measure of my days.
Let me know how frail I am.
5 Behold, you have made my days hand
widths.
My lifetime is as nothing before you.
Surely every man stands as a breath."
Selah.
6 "Surely every man walks like a shadow.
Surely they busy themselves in vain.
He heaps up, and doesn't know who
shall gather.
7 Now, Lord, what do I wait for?
My hope is in you.
8 Deliver me from all my transgressions.
Don't make me the reproach of the
foolish.
9 I was mute.
I didn't open my mouth,
because you did it.
10 Remove your scourge away from me.
I am overcome by the blow of your
hand.
11 When you rebuke and correct man for
iniquity,
you consume his wealth like a moth.
Surely every man is but a breath."
Selah.
12 "Hear my prayer, Yahweh, and give ear
to my cry.
Don't be silent at my tears.
For I am a stranger with you,
a foreigner, as all my fathers were.
13 Oh spare me, that I may recover
strength,
before I go away and exist no more."

40

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 I waited patiently for Yahweh.
He turned to me, and heard my cry.
2 He brought me up also out of a horrible
pit,
out of the miry clay.
He set my feet on a rock,
and gave me a firm place to stand.
3 He has put a new song in my mouth,
even praise to our God.
Many shall see it, and fear, and shall
trust in Yahweh.
4 Blessed is the man who makes Yahweh
his trust,
and doesn't respect the proud, nor
such as turn away to lies.

5 Many, Yahweh, my God, are the
wonderful works which you have
done,
and your thoughts which are toward
us.
They can't be declared back to you.
If I would declare and speak of them,
they are more than can be counted.
6 Sacrifice and offering you didn't desire.
You have opened my ears.
You have not required burnt offering
and sin offering.
7 Then I said, "Behold, I have come.
It is written about me in the book in
the scroll.
8 I delight to do your will, my God.
Yes, your law is within my heart."
9 I have proclaimed glad news of
righteousness in the great
assembly.
Behold, I will not seal my lips,
Yahweh, you know.
10 I have not hidden your righteousness
within my heart.
I have declared your faithfulness and
your salvation.
I have not concealed your loving
kindness and your truth from the
great assembly.
11 Don't withhold your tender mercies
from me, Yahweh.
Let your loving kindness and your
truth continually preserve me.
12 For innumerable evils have surrounded
me.
My iniquities have overtaken me, so
that I am not able to look up.
They are more than the hairs of my head.
My heart has failed me.
13 Be pleased, Yahweh, to deliver me.
Hurry to help me, Yahweh.
14 Let them be disappointed and
confounded together who seek
after my soul to destroy it.
Let them be turned backward and
brought to dishonor who delight in
my hurt.
15 Let them be desolate by reason of their
shame that tell me, "Aha! Aha!"
16 Let all those who seek you rejoice and
be glad in you.
Let such as love your salvation say
continually, "Let Yahweh be
exalted!"
17 But I am poor and needy.
May the Lord think about me.
You are my help and my deliverer.
Don't delay, my God.

41

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 Blessed is he who considers the poor.
Yahweh will deliver him in the day of
evil.
2 Yahweh will preserve him, and keep him
alive.
He shall be blessed on the earth,
and he will not surrender him to the
will of his enemies.
3 Yahweh will sustain him on his sickbed,
and restore him from his bed of
illness.
4 I said, "Yahweh, have mercy on me!
Heal me, for I have sinned against
you."
5 My enemies speak evil against me:
"When will he die, and his name
perish?"
6 If he comes to see me, he speaks
falsehood.
His heart gathers iniquity to itself.
When he goes abroad, he tells it.
7 All who hate me whisper together
against me.
They imagine the worst for me.
8 "An evil disease", they say, "has afflicted
him.
Now that he lies he shall rise up no
more."
9 Yes, my own familiar friend, in whom I
trusted,
who ate bread with me,
has lifted up his heel against me.

10 But you, Yahweh, have mercy on me,
and raise me up,
that I may repay them.
11 By this I know that you delight in me,
because my enemy doesn't triumph
over me.
12 As for me, you uphold me in my
integrity,
and set me in your presence forever.

13 Blessed be Yahweh, the God of Israel,
from everlasting and to everlasting!
Amen and amen.

BOOK 2

42

For the Chief Musician. A contemplation by the sons of Korah.

1 As the deer pants for the water brooks,
so my soul pants after you, God.†
2 My soul thirsts for God, for the living God.
When shall I come and appear before God?
3 My tears have been my food day and night,
while they continually ask me,
"Where is your God?"
4 These things I remember, and pour out my soul within me,
how I used to go with the crowd, and led them to God's house,
with the voice of joy and praise, a multitude keeping a holy day.
5 Why are you in despair, my soul?
Why are you disturbed within me?
Hope in God!
For I shall still praise him for the saving help of his presence.
6 My God, my soul is in despair within me.
Therefore I remember you from the land of the Jordan,
the heights of Hermon, from the hill Mizar.
7 Deep calls to deep at the noise of your waterfalls.
All your waves and your billows have swept over me.

8 Yahweh‡ will command his loving kindness in the daytime.
In the night his song shall be with me:
a prayer to the God of my life.
9 I will ask God, my rock, "Why have you forgotten me?
Why do I go mourning because of the oppression of the enemy?"
10 As with a sword in my bones, my adversaries reproach me,
while they continually ask me,
"Where is your God?"
11 Why are you in despair, my soul?
Why are you disturbed within me?
Hope in God! For I shall still praise him,
the saving help of my countenance, and my God.

43

1 Vindicate me, God, and plead my cause against an ungodly nation.
Oh, deliver me from deceitful and wicked men.
2 For you are the God of my strength. Why have you rejected me?
Why do I go mourning because of the oppression of the enemy?
3 Oh, send out your light and your truth.
Let them lead me.
Let them bring me to your holy hill, to your tents.
4 Then I will go to the altar of God,
to God, my exceeding joy.
I will praise you on the harp, God, my God.
5 Why are you in despair, my soul?
Why are you disturbed within me?
Hope in God!
For I shall still praise him:
my Savior, my helper, and my God.

44

For the Chief Musician. By the sons of Korah. A contemplative psalm.

1 We have heard with our ears, God;
our fathers have told us what work you did in their days,
in the days of old.
2 You drove out the nations with your hand,
but you planted them.
You afflicted the peoples,
but you spread them abroad.
3 For they didn't get the land in possession by their own sword,
neither did their own arm save them;
but your right hand, your arm, and the light of your face,
because you were favorable to them.
4 God, you are my King.
Command victories for Jacob!

† **42:1** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

‡ **42:8** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations.

5 Through you, we will push down our
adversaries.
Through your name, we will tread
down those who rise up against us.
6 For I will not trust in my bow,
neither will my sword save me.
7 But you have saved us from our
adversaries,
and have shamed those who hate us.
8 In God we have made our boast all day
long.
We will give thanks to your name
forever.
Selah.

9 But now you rejected us, and brought us
to dishonor,
and don't go out with our armies.
10 You make us turn back from the
adversary.
Those who hate us take plunder for
themselves.
11 You have made us like sheep for food,
and have scattered us among the
nations.
12 You sell your people for nothing,
and have gained nothing from their
sale.
13 You make us a reproach to our
neighbors,
a scoffing and a derision to those who
are around us.
14 You make us a byword among the
nations,
a shaking of the head among the
peoples.
15 All day long my dishonor is before me,
and shame covers my face,
16 at the taunt of one who reproaches
and verbally abuses,
because of the enemy and the
avenger.
17 All this has come on us,
yet we haven't forgotten you.
We haven't been false to your
covenant.
18 Our heart has not turned back,
neither have our steps strayed from
your path,
19 though you have crushed us in the
haunt of jackals,
and covered us with the shadow of
death.
20 If we have forgotten the name of our
God,
or spread out our hands to a strange
god,
21 won't God search this out?
For he knows the secrets of the heart.
22 Yes, for your sake we are killed all day
long.
We are regarded as sheep for the
slaughter.
23 Wake up!
Why do you sleep, Lord?†
Arise!
Don't reject us forever.
24 Why do you hide your face,
and forget our affliction and our
oppression?
25 For our soul is bowed down to the dust.
Our body clings to the earth.
26 Rise up to help us.
Redeem us for your loving kindness'
sake.

† **44:23** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai."

45

For the Chief Musician. Set to "The Lilies."
A contemplation by the sons of Korah. A
wedding song.
1 My heart overflows with a noble theme.
I recite my verses for the king.
My tongue is like the pen of a skillful
writer.
2 You are the most excellent of the sons of
men.
Grace has anointed your lips,
therefore God has blessed you
forever.
3 Strap your sword on your thigh, O
mighty one,
in your splendor and your majesty.
4 In your majesty ride on victoriously on
behalf of truth, humility, and
righteousness.
Let your right hand display awesome
deeds.
5 Your arrows are sharp.
The nations fall under you, with
arrows in the heart of the king's
enemies.
6 Your throne, God, is forever and ever.

A scepter of equity is the scepter of
your kingdom.
7 You have loved righteousness, and hated
wickedness.
Therefore God, your God, has
anointed you with the oil of
gladness above your fellows.
8 All your garments smell like myrrh,
aloes, and cassia.
Out of ivory palaces stringed
instruments have made you glad.
9 Kings' daughters are among your
honorable women.
At your right hand the queen stands
in gold of Ophir.
10 Listen, daughter, consider, and turn
your ear.
Forget your own people, and also
your father's house.
11 So the king will desire your beauty,
honor him, for he is your lord.
12 The daughter of Tyre comes with a gift.
The rich among the people entreat
your favor.
13 The princess inside is all glorious.
Her clothing is interwoven with gold.
14 She shall be led to the king in
embroidered work.
The virgins, her companions who
follow her, shall be brought to you.
15 With gladness and rejoicing they shall
be led.
They shall enter into the king's palace.
16 Your sons will take the place of your
fathers.
You shall make them princes in all the
earth.
17 I will make your name to be
remembered in all generations.
Therefore the peoples shall give you
thanks forever and ever.

46

For the Chief Musician. By the sons of
Korah. According to Alamoth.†
1 God is our refuge and strength,
a very present help in trouble.
2 Therefore we won't be afraid, though the
earth changes,
though the mountains are shaken
into the heart of the seas;
3 though its waters roar and are
troubled,
though the mountains tremble with
their swelling.
Selah.

4 There is a river, the streams of which
make the city of God glad,
the holy place of the tents of the Most
High.
5 God is within her. She shall not be
moved.
God will help her at dawn.
6 The nations raged. The kingdoms were
moved.
He lifted his voice and the earth
melted.
7 Yahweh of Armies is with us.
The God of Jacob is our refuge.
Selah.

8 Come, see Yahweh's works,
what desolations he has made in the
earth.
9 He makes wars cease to the end of the
earth.
He breaks the bow, and shatters the
spear.
He burns the chariots in the fire.
10 "Be still, and know that I am God.
I will be exalted among the nations.
I will be exalted in the earth."
11 Yahweh of Armies is with us.
The God of Jacob is our refuge.
Selah.

47

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by the
sons of Korah.
1 Oh clap your hands, all you nations.
Shout to God with the voice of
triumph!
2 For Yahweh Most High is awesome.
He is a great King over all the earth.
3 He subdues nations under us,
and peoples under our feet.
4 He chooses our inheritance for us,
the glory of Jacob whom he loved.
Selah.
5 God has gone up with a shout,
Yahweh with the sound of a trumpet.
6 Sing praises to God! Sing praises!
Sing praises to our King! Sing praises!

† **46:** Alamoth is a musical term.

7 For God is the King of all the earth.
Sing praises with understanding.
8 God reigns over the nations.
God sits on his holy throne.
9 The princes of the peoples are gathered together,
the people of the God of Abraham.
For the shields of the earth belong to God.
He is greatly exalted!

48

A Song. A Psalm by the sons of Korah.
1 Great is Yahweh, and greatly to be praised,
in the city of our God, in his holy mountain.
2 Beautiful in elevation, the joy of the whole earth,
is Mount Zion, on the north sides,
the city of the great King.
3 God has shown himself in her citadels as a refuge.
4 For, behold, the kings assembled themselves,
they passed by together.
5 They saw it, then they were amazed.
They were dismayed.
They hurried away.
6 Trembling took hold of them there,
pain, as of a woman in travail.
7 With the east wind, you break the ships of Tarshish.
8 As we have heard, so we have seen,
in the city of Yahweh of Armies, in the city of our God.
God will establish it forever.
Selah.
9 We have thought about your loving kindness, God,
in the middle of your temple.
10 As is your name, God,
so is your praise to the ends of the earth.
Your right hand is full of righteousness.
11 Let Mount Zion be glad!
Let the daughters of Judah rejoice because of your judgments.
12 Walk about Zion, and go around her.
Number its towers.
13 Notice her bulwarks.
Consider her palaces,
that you may tell it to the next generation.
14 For this God is our God forever and ever.
He will be our guide even to death.

49

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by the sons of Korah.
1 Hear this, all you peoples.
Listen, all you inhabitants of the world,
2 both low and high,
rich and poor together.
3 My mouth will speak words of wisdom.
My heart will utter understanding.
4 I will incline my ear to a proverb.
I will solve my riddle on the harp.
5 Why should I fear in the days of evil,
when iniquity at my heels surrounds me?
6 Those who trust in their wealth,
and boast in the multitude of their riches—
7 none of them can by any means redeem his brother,
nor give God a ransom for him.
8 For the redemption of their life is costly,
no payment is ever enough,
9 that he should live on forever,
that he should not see corruption.
10 For he sees that wise men die;
likewise the fool and the senseless perish,
and leave their wealth to others.
11 Their inward thought is that their houses will endure forever,
and their dwelling places to all generations.
They name their lands after themselves.
12 But man, despite his riches, doesn't endure.
He is like the animals that perish.

13 This is the destiny of those who are foolish,
and of those who approve their sayings.
Selah.

† **49:14** Sheol is the place of the dead.

14 They are appointed as a flock for Sheol.†
Death shall be their shepherd.
The upright shall have dominion over them in the morning.
Their beauty shall decay in Sheol,‡
far from their mansion.
15 But God will redeem my soul from the power of Sheol,§
for he will receive me.
Selah.
16 Don't be afraid when a man is made rich,
when the glory of his house is increased;
17 for when he dies he will carry nothing away.
His glory won't descend after him.
18 Though while he lived he blessed his soul—
and men praise you when you do well for yourself—
19 he shall go to the generation of his fathers.
They shall never see the light.
20 A man who has riches without understanding,
is like the animals that perish.

50

A Psalm by Asaph.
1 The Mighty One, God, Yahweh, speaks,
and calls the earth from sunrise to sunset.
2 Out of Zion, the perfection of beauty,
God shines out.
3 Our God comes, and does not keep silent.
A fire devours before him.
It is very stormy around him.
4 He calls to the heavens above,
to the earth, that he may judge his people:
5 "Gather my saints together to me,
those who have made a covenant with me by sacrifice."
6 The heavens shall declare his righteousness,
for God himself is judge.
Selah.
7 "Hear, my people, and I will speak.
Israel, I will testify against you.
I am God, your God.
8 I don't rebuke you for your sacrifices.
Your burnt offerings are continually before me.
9 I have no need for a bull from your stall,
nor male goats from your pens.
10 For every animal of the forest is mine,
and the livestock on a thousand hills.
11 I know all the birds of the mountains.
The wild animals of the field are mine.
12 If I were hungry, I would not tell you,
for the world is mine, and all that is in it.
13 Will I eat the meat of bulls,
or drink the blood of goats?
14 Offer to God the sacrifice of thanksgiving.
Pay your vows to the Most High.
15 Call on me in the day of trouble.
I will deliver you, and you will honor me."

16 But to the wicked God says,
"What right do you have to declare my statutes,
that you have taken my covenant on your lips,
17 since you hate instruction,
and throw my words behind you?
18 When you saw a thief, you consented with him,
and have participated with adulterers.

19 "You give your mouth to evil.
Your tongue frames deceit.
20 You sit and speak against your brother.
You slander your own mother's son.
21 You have done these things, and I kept silent.
You thought that I was just like you.
I will rebuke you, and accuse you in front of your eyes.

22 "Now consider this, you who forget God,
lest I tear you into pieces, and there be no one to deliver.
23 Whoever offers the sacrifice of thanksgiving glorifies me,
and prepares his way so that I will show God's salvation to him."

‡ **49:14** Sheol is the place of the dead.
§ **49:15** Sheol is the place of the dead.

51

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David, when Nathan the prophet came to him, after he had gone in to Bathsheba.

1 Have mercy on me, God, according to your loving kindness.
According to the multitude of your tender mercies, blot out my transgressions.
2 Wash me thoroughly from my iniquity.
Cleanse me from my sin.
3 For I know my transgressions.
My sin is constantly before me.
4 Against you, and you only, I have sinned,
and done that which is evil in your sight,
so you may be proved right when you speak,
and justified when you judge.
5 Behold, I was born in iniquity.
My mother conceived me in sin.
6 Behold, you desire truth in the inward parts.
You teach me wisdom in the inmost place.
7 Purify me with hyssop, and I will be clean.
Wash me, and I will be whiter than snow.
8 Let me hear joy and gladness,
that the bones which you have broken may rejoice.
9 Hide your face from my sins,
and blot out all of my iniquities.
10 Create in me a clean heart, O God.
Renew a right spirit within me.
11 Don't throw me from your presence,
and don't take your Holy Spirit from me.
12 Restore to me the joy of your salvation.
Uphold me with a willing spirit.
13 Then I will teach transgressors your ways.
Sinners will be converted to you.
14 Deliver me from the guilt of bloodshed,
O God, the God of my salvation.
My tongue will sing aloud of your righteousness.
15 Lord, open my lips.
My mouth will declare your praise.
16 For you don't delight in sacrifice, or else I would give it.
You have no pleasure in burnt offering.
17 The sacrifices of God are a broken spirit.
O God, you will not despise a broken and contrite heart.

18 Do well in your good pleasure to Zion.
Build the walls of Jerusalem.
19 Then you will delight in the sacrifices of righteousness,
in burnt offerings and in whole burnt offerings.
Then they will offer bulls on your altar.

52

For the Chief Musician. A contemplation by David, when Doeg the Edomite came and told Saul, "David has come to Ahimelech's house."

1 Why do you boast of mischief, mighty man?
God's loving kindness endures continually.
2 Your tongue plots destruction,
like a sharp razor, working deceitfully.
3 You love evil more than good,
lying rather than speaking the truth.
Selah.
4 You love all devouring words,
you deceitful tongue.
5 God will likewise destroy you forever.
He will take you up, and pluck you out of your tent,
and root you out of the land of the living.
Selah.
6 The righteous also will see it, and fear,
and laugh at him, saying,
7 "Behold, this is the man who didn't make God his strength,
but trusted in the abundance of his riches,
and strengthened himself in his wickedness."
8 But as for me, I am like a green olive tree in God's house.
I trust in God's loving kindness forever and ever.
9 I will give you thanks forever, because you have done it.
I will hope in your name, for it is good,

in the presence of your saints.

53

For the Chief Musician. To the tune of "Mahalath." A contemplation by David.

1 The fool has said in his heart, "There is no God."
They are corrupt, and have done abominable iniquity.
There is no one who does good.
2 God looks down from heaven on the children of men,
to see if there are any who understood,
who seek after God.
3 Every one of them has gone back.
They have become filthy together.
There is no one who does good, no, not one.
4 Have the workers of iniquity no knowledge,
who eat up my people as they eat bread,
and don't call on God?
5 There they were in great fear, where no fear was,
for God has scattered the bones of him who encamps against you.
You have put them to shame,
because God has rejected them.
6 Oh that the salvation of Israel would come out of Zion!
When God brings back his people from captivity,
then Jacob shall rejoice,
and Israel shall be glad.

54

For the Chief Musician. On stringed instruments. A contemplation by David, when the Ziphites came and said to Saul, "Isn't David hiding himself among us?"

1 Save me, God, by your name.
Vindicate me in your might.
2 Hear my prayer, God.
Listen to the words of my mouth.
3 For strangers have risen up against me.
Violent men have sought after my soul.
They haven't set God before them.
Selah.
4 Behold, God is my helper.
The Lord is the one who sustains my soul.
5 He will repay the evil to my enemies.
Destroy them in your truth.
6 With a free will offering, I will sacrifice to you.
I will give thanks to your name, Yahweh, for it is good.
7 For he has delivered me out of all trouble.
My eye has seen triumph over my enemies.

55

For the Chief Musician. On stringed instruments. A contemplation by David.

1 Listen to my prayer, God.
Don't hide yourself from my supplication.
2 Attend to me, and answer me.
I am restless in my complaint,
and moan
3 because of the voice of the enemy,
because of the oppression of the wicked.
For they bring suffering on me.
In anger they hold a grudge against me.
4 My heart is severely pained within me.
The terrors of death have fallen on me.
5 Fearfulness and trembling have come on me.
Horror has overwhelmed me.
6 I said, "Oh that I had wings like a dove!
Then I would fly away, and be at rest.
7 Behold, then I would wander far off.
I would lodge in the wilderness."
Selah.
8 "I would hurry to a shelter from the stormy wind and storm."
9 Confuse them, Lord, and confound their language,
for I have seen violence and strife in the city.
10 Day and night they prowl around on its walls.
Malice and abuse are also within her.
11 Destructive forces are within her.
Threats and lies don't depart from her streets.
12 For it was not an enemy who insulted me,
then I could have endured it.

Neither was it he who hated me who
raised himself up against me,
then I would have hidden myself
from him.
13 But it was you, a man like me,
my companion, and my familiar
friend.
14 We took sweet fellowship together.
We walked in God's house with
company.
15 Let death come suddenly on them.
Let them go down alive into Sheol.†
For wickedness is among them, in
their dwelling.
16 As for me, I will call on God.
Yahweh will save me.
17 Evening, morning, and at noon, I will
cry out in distress.
He will hear my voice.
18 He has redeemed my soul in peace from
the battle that was against me,
although there are many who oppose
me.
19 God, who is enthroned forever,
will hear and answer them.
Selah.

They never change
and don't fear God.
20 He raises his hands against his friends.
He has violated his covenant.
21 His mouth was smooth as butter,
but his heart was war.
His words were softer than oil,
yet they were drawn swords.

22 Cast your burden on Yahweh and he
will sustain you.
He will never allow the righteous to
be moved.
23 But you, God, will bring them down into
the pit of destruction.
Bloodthirsty and deceitful men shall
not live out half their days,
but I will trust in you.

56

For the Chief Musician. To the tune of "Silent Dove in Distant Lands." A poem by David, when the Philistines seized him in Gath.
1 Be merciful to me, God, for man wants to
swallow me up.
All day long, he attacks and oppresses
me.
2 My enemies want to swallow me up all
day long,
for they are many who fight proudly
against me.
3 When I am afraid,
I will put my trust in you.
4 In God, I praise his word.
In God, I put my trust.
I will not be afraid.
What can flesh do to me?
5 All day long they twist my words.
All their thoughts are against me for
evil.
6 They conspire and lurk,
watching my steps.
They are eager to take my life.
7 Shall they escape by iniquity?
In anger cast down the peoples, God.
8 You count my wanderings.
You put my tears into your container.
Aren't they in your book?
9 Then my enemies shall turn back in the
day that I call.
I know this: that God is for me.
10 In God, I will praise his word.
In Yahweh, I will praise his word.
11 I have put my trust in God.
I will not be afraid.
What can man do to me?
12 Your vows are on me, God.
I will give thank offerings to you.
13 For you have delivered my soul from
death,
and prevented my feet from falling,
that I may walk before God in the
light of the living.

57

For the Chief Musician. To the tune of "Do Not Destroy." A poem by David, when he fled from Saul, in the cave.
1 Be merciful to me, God, be merciful to
me,
for my soul takes refuge in you.
Yes, in the shadow of your wings, I will
take refuge,
until disaster has passed.
2 I cry out to God Most High,

† **55:15** Sheol is the place of the dead.

to God who accomplishes my requests for me.
3 He will send from heaven, and save me,
he rebukes the one who is pursuing me.
Selah.
God will send out his loving kindness and his truth.
4 My soul is among lions.
I lie among those who are set on fire,
even the sons of men, whose teeth are spears and arrows,
and their tongue a sharp sword.
5 Be exalted, God, above the heavens!
Let your glory be above all the earth!

6 They have prepared a net for my steps.
My soul is bowed down.
They dig a pit before me.
They fall into the middle of it themselves.
Selah.
7 My heart is steadfast, God.
My heart is steadfast.
I will sing, yes, I will sing praises.
8 Wake up, my glory! Wake up, lute and harp!
I will wake up the dawn.
9 I will give thanks to you, Lord, among the peoples.
I will sing praises to you among the nations.
10 For your great loving kindness reaches to the heavens,
and your truth to the skies.
11 Be exalted, God, above the heavens.
Let your glory be over all the earth.

58

For the Chief Musician. To the tune of "Do Not Destroy." A poem by David.
1 Do you indeed speak righteousness, silent ones?
Do you judge blamelessly, you sons of men?
2 No, in your heart you plot injustice.
You measure out the violence of your hands in the earth.
3 The wicked go astray from the womb.
They are wayward as soon as they are born, speaking lies.
4 Their poison is like the poison of a snake,
like a deaf cobra that stops its ear,
5 which doesn't listen to the voice of charmers,
no matter how skillful the charmer may be.
6 Break their teeth, God, in their mouth.
Break out the great teeth of the young lions, Yahweh.
7 Let them vanish like water that flows away.
When they draw the bow, let their arrows be made blunt.
8 Let them be like a snail which melts and passes away,
like the stillborn child, who has not seen the sun.
9 Before your pots can feel the heat of the thorns,
he will sweep away the green and the burning alike.
10 The righteous shall rejoice when he sees the vengeance.
He shall wash his feet in the blood of the wicked,
11 so that men shall say, "Most certainly there is a reward for the righteous.
Most certainly there is a God who judges the earth."

59

For the Chief Musician. To the tune of "Do Not Destroy." A poem by David, when Saul sent, and they watched the house to kill him.
1 Deliver me from my enemies, my God.
Set me on high from those who rise up against me.
2 Deliver me from the workers of iniquity.
Save me from the bloodthirsty men.
3 For, behold, they lie in wait for my soul.
The mighty gather themselves together against me,
not for my disobedience, nor for my sin, Yahweh.
4 I have done no wrong, yet they are ready to attack me.
Rise up, behold, and help me!
5 You, Yahweh God of Armies, the God of Israel,
rouse yourself to punish the nations.
Show no mercy to the wicked traitors.
Selah.
6 They return at evening, howling like dogs,

and prowl around the city.
7 Behold, they spew with their mouth.
Swords are in their lips,
"For", they say, "who hears us?"
8 But you, Yahweh, laugh at them.
You scoff at all the nations.
9 Oh, my Strength, I watch for you,
for God is my high tower.
10 My God will go before me with his loving kindness.
God will let me look at my enemies in triumph.
11 Don't kill them, or my people may forget.
Scatter them by your power, and bring them down, Lord our shield.
12 For the sin of their mouth, and the words of their lips,
let them be caught in their pride,
for the curses and lies which they utter.
13 Consume them in wrath.
Consume them, and they will be no more.
Let them know that God rules in Jacob,
to the ends of the earth.
Selah.
14 At evening let them return.
Let them howl like a dog, and go around the city.
15 They shall wander up and down for food,
and wait all night if they aren't satisfied.

16 But I will sing of your strength.
Yes, I will sing aloud of your loving kindness in the morning.
For you have been my high tower,
a refuge in the day of my distress.
17 To you, my strength, I will sing praises.
For God is my high tower, the God of my mercy.

60

For the Chief Musician. To the tune of "The Lily of the Covenant." A teaching poem by David, when he fought with Aram Naharaim and with Aram Zobah, and Joab returned, and killed twelve thousand of Edom in the Valley of Salt.
1 God, you have rejected us.
You have broken us down.
You have been angry.
Restore us, again.
2 You have made the land tremble.
You have torn it.
Mend its fractures,
for it quakes.
3 You have shown your people hard things.
You have made us drink the wine that makes us stagger.
4 You have given a banner to those who fear you,
that it may be displayed because of the truth.
Selah.

5 So that your beloved may be delivered,
save with your right hand, and answer us.
6 God has spoken from his sanctuary:
"I will triumph.
I will divide Shechem,
and measure out the valley of Succoth.
7 Gilead is mine, and Manasseh is mine.
Ephraim also is the defense of my head.
Judah is my scepter.
8 Moab is my wash basin.
I will throw my sandal on Edom.
I shout in triumph over Philistia."

9 Who will bring me into the strong city?
Who has led me to Edom?
10 Haven't you, God, rejected us?
You don't go out with our armies, God.
11 Give us help against the adversary,
for the help of man is vain.
12 Through God we will do valiantly,
for it is he who will tread down our adversaries.

61

For the Chief Musician. For a stringed instrument. By David.
1 Hear my cry, God.
Listen to my prayer.
2 From the end of the earth, I will call to you when my heart is overwhelmed.
Lead me to the rock that is higher than I.
3 For you have been a refuge for me,

a strong tower from the enemy.
4 I will dwell in your tent forever.
I will take refuge in the shelter of your wings.
Selah.
5 For you, God, have heard my vows.
You have given me the heritage of those who fear your name.
6 You will prolong the king's life.
His years will be for generations.
7 He shall be enthroned in God's presence forever.
Appoint your loving kindness and truth, that they may preserve him.
8 So I will sing praise to your name forever,
that I may fulfill my vows daily.

62

For the Chief Musician. To Jeduthun. A Psalm by David.
1 My soul rests in God alone.
My salvation is from him.
2 He alone is my rock, my salvation, and my fortress.
I will never be greatly shaken.
3 How long will you assault a man?
Would all of you throw him down,
like a leaning wall, like a tottering fence?
4 They fully intend to throw him down from his lofty place.
They delight in lies.
They bless with their mouth, but they curse inwardly.
Selah.
5 My soul, wait in silence for God alone,
for my expectation is from him.
6 He alone is my rock and my salvation, my fortress.
I will not be shaken.
7 My salvation and my honor is with God.
The rock of my strength, and my refuge, is in God.
8 Trust in him at all times, you people.
Pour out your heart before him.
God is a refuge for us.
Selah.
9 Surely men of low degree are just a breath,
and men of high degree are a lie.
In the balances they will go up.
They are together lighter than a breath.
10 Don't trust in oppression.
Don't become vain in robbery.
If riches increase,
don't set your heart on them.
11 God has spoken once;
twice I have heard this,
that power belongs to God.
12 Also to you, Lord, belongs loving kindness,
for you reward every man according to his work.

63

A Psalm by David, when he was in the desert of Judah.
1 God, you are my God.
I will earnestly seek you.
My soul thirsts for you.
My flesh longs for you,
in a dry and weary land, where there is no water.
2 So I have seen you in the sanctuary,
watching your power and your glory.
3 Because your loving kindness is better than life,
my lips shall praise you.
4 So I will bless you while I live.
I will lift up my hands in your name.
5 My soul shall be satisfied as with the richest food.
My mouth shall praise you with joyful lips,
6 when I remember you on my bed,
and think about you in the night watches.
7 For you have been my help.
I will rejoice in the shadow of your wings.
8 My soul stays close to you.
Your right hand holds me up.
9 But those who seek my soul to destroy it shall go into the lower parts of the earth.
10 They shall be given over to the power of the sword.
They shall be jackal food.
11 But the king shall rejoice in God.
Everyone who swears by him will praise him,

for the mouth of those who speak lies
shall be silenced.

64

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 Hear my voice, God, in my complaint.
Preserve my life from fear of the
enemy.
2 Hide me from the conspiracy of the
wicked,
from the noisy crowd of the ones
doing evil;
3 who sharpen their tongue like a sword,
and aim their arrows, deadly words,
4 to shoot innocent men from
ambushes.
They shoot at him suddenly and
fearlessly.
5 They encourage themselves in evil plans.
They talk about laying snares secretly.
They say, “Who will see them?”
6 They plot injustice, saying, “We have
made a perfect plan!”
Surely man’s mind and heart are
cunning.
7 But God will shoot at them.
They will be suddenly struck down
with an arrow.
8 Their own tongues shall ruin them.
All who see them will shake their
heads.
9 All mankind shall be afraid.
They shall declare the work of God,
and shall wisely ponder what he has
done.
10 The righteous shall be glad in Yahweh,
and shall take refuge in him.
All the upright in heart shall praise
him!

65

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
A song.
1 Praise waits for you, God, in Zion.
Vows shall be performed to you.
2 You who hear prayer,
all men will come to you.
3 Sins overwhelmed me,
but you atoned for our
transgressions.
4 Blessed is the one whom you choose and
cause to come near,
that he may live in your courts.
We will be filled with the goodness of
your house,
your holy temple.
5 By awesome deeds of righteousness, you
answer us,
God of our salvation.
You who are the hope of all the ends of the
earth,
of those who are far away on the sea.
6 By your power, you form the mountains,
having armed yourself with strength.
7 You still the roaring of the seas,
the roaring of their waves,
and the turmoil of the nations.
8 They also who dwell in faraway places
are afraid at your wonders.
You call the morning’s dawn and the
evening with songs of joy.
9 You visit the earth, and water it.
You greatly enrich it.
The river of God is full of water.
You provide them grain, for so you
have ordained it.
10 You drench its furrows.
You level its ridges.
You soften it with showers.
You bless it with a crop.
11 You crown the year with your bounty.
Your carts overflow with abundance.
12 The wilderness grasslands overflow.
The hills are clothed with gladness.
13 The pastures are covered with flocks.
The valleys also are clothed with
grain.
They shout for joy!
They also sing.

66

For the Chief Musician. A song. A Psalm.
1 Make a joyful shout to God, all the earth!
2 Sing to the glory of his name!
Offer glory and praise!
3 Tell God, “How awesome are your deeds!
Through the greatness of your power,
your enemies submit themselves to
you.
4 All the earth will worship you,
and will sing to you;
they will sing to your name.”
Selah.
5 Come, and see God’s deeds—

awesome work on behalf of the
children of men.
6 He turned the sea into dry land.
They went through the river on foot.
There, we rejoiced in him.
7 He rules by his might forever.
His eyes watch the nations.
Don't let the rebellious rise up against
him.
Selah.
8 Praise our God, you peoples!
Make the sound of his praise heard,
9 who preserves our life among the living,
and doesn't allow our feet to be
moved.
10 For you, God, have tested us.
You have refined us, as silver is
refined.
11 You brought us into prison.
You laid a burden on our backs.
12 You allowed men to ride over our heads.
We went through fire and through
water,
but you brought us to the place of
abundance.
13 I will come into your temple with burnt
offerings.
I will pay my vows to you,
14 which my lips promised,
and my mouth spoke, when I was in
distress.
15 I will offer to you burnt offerings of fat
animals,
with the offering of rams,
I will offer bulls with goats.
Selah.
16 Come and hear, all you who fear God.
I will declare what he has done for my
soul.
17 I cried to him with my mouth.
He was extolled with my tongue.
18 If I cherished sin in my heart,
the Lord wouldn't have listened.
19 But most certainly, God has listened.
He has heard the voice of my prayer.
20 Blessed be God, who has not turned
away my prayer,
nor his loving kindness from me.

67

For the Chief Musician. With stringed
instruments. A Psalm. A song.
1 May God be merciful to us, bless us,
and cause his face to shine on us.
Selah.
2 That your way may be known on earth,
and your salvation among all nations,
3 let the peoples praise you, God.
Let all the peoples praise you.
4 Oh let the nations be glad and sing for
joy,
for you will judge the peoples with
equity,
and govern the nations on earth.
Selah.
5 Let the peoples praise you, God.
Let all the peoples praise you.
6 The earth has yielded its increase.
God, even our own God, will bless us.
7 God will bless us.
All the ends of the earth shall fear
him.

68

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
A song.
1 Let God arise!
Let his enemies be scattered!
Let them who hate him also flee
before him.
2 As smoke is driven away,
so drive them away.
As wax melts before the fire,
so let the wicked perish at the
presence of God.
3 But let the righteous be glad.
Let them rejoice before God.
Yes, let them rejoice with gladness.
4 Sing to God! Sing praises to his name!
Extol him who rides on the clouds:
to Yah, his name!
Rejoice before him!
5 A father of the fatherless, and a defender
of the widows,
is God in his holy habitation.
6 God sets the lonely in families.
He brings out the prisoners with singing,
but the rebellious dwell in a
sun-scorched land.

7 God, when you went out before your
people,
when you marched through the
wilderness...
Selah.
8 The earth trembled.

The sky also poured down rain at the
presence of the God of Sinai—
at the presence of God, the God of
Israel.
9 You, God, sent a plentiful rain.
You confirmed your inheritance
when it was weary.
10 Your congregation lived therein.
You, God, prepared your goodness for
the poor.
11 The Lord announced the word.
The ones who proclaim it are a great
company.
12 "Kings of armies flee! They flee!"
She who waits at home divides the
plunder,
13 while you sleep among the camp
fires,
the wings of a dove sheathed with
silver,
her feathers with shining gold.
14 When the Almighty scattered kings in
her,
it snowed on Zalmon.
15 The mountains of Bashan are majestic
mountains.
The mountains of Bashan are rugged.
16 Why do you look in envy, you rugged
mountains,
at the mountain where God chooses
to reign?
Yes, Yahweh will dwell there forever.
17 The chariots of God are tens of
thousands and thousands of
thousands.
The Lord is among them, from Sinai,
into the sanctuary.
18 You have ascended on high.
You have led away captives.
You have received gifts among people,
yes, among the rebellious also, that
Yah God might dwell there.

19 Blessed be the Lord, who daily bears
our burdens,
even the God who is our salvation.
Selah.
20 God is to us a God of deliverance.
To Yahweh, the Lord, belongs escape
from death.
21 But God will strike through the head of
his enemies,
the hairy scalp of such a one as still
continues in his guiltiness.
22 The Lord said, "I will bring you again
from Bashan,
I will bring you again from the depths
of the sea,
23 that you may crush them, dipping your
foot in blood,
that the tongues of your dogs may
have their portion from your
enemies."
24 They have seen your processions, God,
even the processions of my God, my
King, into the sanctuary.
25 The singers went before, the minstrels
followed after,
among the ladies playing with
tambourines,
26 "Bless God in the congregations,
even the Lord in the assembly of
Israel!"
27 There is little Benjamin, their ruler,
the princes of Judah, their council,
the princes of Zebulun, and the
princes of Naphtali.

28 Your God has commanded your
strength.
Strengthen, God, that which you have
done for us.
29 Because of your temple at Jerusalem,
kings shall bring presents to you.
30 Rebuke the wild animal of the reeds,
the multitude of the bulls with the
calves of the peoples.
Trample under foot the bars of silver.
Scatter the nations who delight in
war.
31 Princes shall come out of Egypt.
Ethiopia shall hurry to stretch out her
hands to God.
32 Sing to God, you kingdoms of the earth!
Sing praises to the Lord—
Selah—
33 to him who rides on the heaven of
heavens, which are of old;
behold, he utters his voice, a mighty
voice.
34 Ascribe strength to God!
His excellency is over Israel,
his strength is in the skies.
35 You are awesome, God, in your
sanctuaries.

The God of Israel gives strength and
power to his people.
Praise be to God!

69

For the Chief Musician. To the tune of
“Lilies.” By David.

1 Save me, God,
for the waters have come up to my
neck!
2 I sink in deep mire, where there is no
foothold.
I have come into deep waters, where
the floods overflow me.
3 I am weary with my crying.
My throat is dry.
My eyes fail looking for my God.
4 Those who hate me without a cause are
more than the hairs of my head.
Those who want to cut me off, being
my enemies wrongfully, are
mighty.
I have to restore what I didn’t take
away.
5 God, you know my foolishness.
My sins aren’t hidden from you.
6 Don’t let those who wait for you be
shamed through me, Lord Yahweh
of Armies.
Don’t let those who seek you be
brought to dishonor through me,
God of Israel.
7 Because for your sake, I have borne
reproach.
Shame has covered my face.
8 I have become a stranger to my brothers,
an alien to my mother’s children.
9 For the zeal of your house consumes me.
The reproaches of those who
reproach you have fallen on me.
10 When I wept and I fasted,
that was to my reproach.
11 When I made sackcloth my clothing,
I became a byword to them.
12 Those who sit in the gate talk about me.
I am the song of the drunkards.
13 But as for me, my prayer is to you,
Yahweh, in an acceptable time.
God, in the abundance of your loving
kindness, answer me in the truth of
your salvation.
14 Deliver me out of the mire, and don’t let
me sink.
Let me be delivered from those who
hate me, and out of the deep waters.
15 Don’t let the flood waters overwhelm
me,
neither let the deep swallow me up.
Don’t let the pit shut its mouth on me.
16 Answer me, Yahweh, for your loving
kindness is good.
According to the multitude of your
tender mercies, turn to me.
17 Don’t hide your face from your servant,
for I am in distress.
Answer me speedily!
18 Draw near to my soul and redeem it.
Ransom me because of my enemies.
19 You know my reproach, my shame, and
my dishonor.
My adversaries are all before you.
20 Reproach has broken my heart, and I
am full of heaviness.
I looked for some to take pity, but
there was none;
for comforters, but I found none.
21 They also gave me poison for my food.
In my thirst, they gave me vinegar to
drink.
22 Let their table before them become a
snare.
May it become a retribution and a
trap.
23 Let their eyes be darkened, so that they
can’t see.
Let their backs be continually bent.
24 Pour out your indignation on them.
Let the fierceness of your anger
overtake them.
25 Let their habitation be desolate.
Let no one dwell in their tents.
26 For they persecute him whom you have
wounded.
They tell of the sorrow of those whom
you have hurt.
27 Charge them with crime upon crime.
Don’t let them come into your
righteousness.
28 Let them be blotted out of the book of
life,
and not be written with the righteous.
29 But I am in pain and distress.
Let your salvation, God, protect me.

30 I will praise the name of God with a song,
and will magnify him with thanksgiving.
31 It will please Yahweh better than an ox,
or a bull that has horns and hoofs.
32 The humble have seen it, and are glad.
You who seek after God, let your heart live.
33 For Yahweh hears the needy,
and doesn't despise his captive people.
34 Let heaven and earth praise him;
the seas, and everything that moves therein!
35 For God will save Zion, and build the cities of Judah.
They shall settle there, and own it.
36 The children also of his servants shall inherit it.
Those who love his name shall dwell therein.

70

For the Chief Musician. By David. A reminder.
1 Hurry, God, to deliver me.
Come quickly to help me, Yahweh.
2 Let them be disappointed and confounded who seek my soul.
Let those who desire my ruin be turned back in disgrace.
3 Let them be turned because of their shame
who say, "Aha! Aha!"
4 Let all those who seek you rejoice and be glad in you.
Let those who love your salvation continually say,
"Let God be exalted!"
5 But I am poor and needy.
Come to me quickly, God.
You are my help and my deliverer.
Yahweh, don't delay.

71

1 In you, Yahweh, I take refuge.
Never let me be disappointed.
2 Deliver me in your righteousness, and rescue me.
Turn your ear to me, and save me.
3 Be to me a rock of refuge to which I may always go.
Give the command to save me,
for you are my rock and my fortress.
4 Rescue me, my God, from the hand of the wicked,
from the hand of the unrighteous and cruel man.
5 For you are my hope, Lord Yahweh,
my confidence from my youth.
6 I have relied on you from the womb.
You are he who took me out of my mother's womb.
I will always praise you.
7 I am a marvel to many,
but you are my strong refuge.
8 My mouth shall be filled with your praise,
with your honor all day long.
9 Don't reject me in my old age.
Don't forsake me when my strength fails.
10 For my enemies talk about me.
Those who watch for my soul conspire together,
11 saying, "God has forsaken him.
Pursue and take him, for no one will rescue him."
12 God, don't be far from me.
My God, hurry to help me.
13 Let my accusers be disappointed and consumed.
Let them be covered with disgrace and scorn who want to harm me.
14 But I will always hope,
and will add to all of your praise.
15 My mouth will tell about your righteousness,
and of your salvation all day,
though I don't know its full measure.
16 I will come with the mighty acts of the Lord Yahweh.
I will make mention of your righteousness, even of yours alone.
17 God, you have taught me from my youth.
Until now, I have declared your wondrous works.
18 Yes, even when I am old and gray-haired, God, don't forsake me,
until I have declared your strength to the next generation,

your might to everyone who is to come.
19 God, your righteousness also reaches to the heavens.
You have done great things.
God, who is like you?
20 You, who have shown us many and bitter troubles,
you will let me live.
You will bring us up again from the depths of the earth.
21 Increase my honor
and comfort me again.
22 I will also praise you with the harp for your faithfulness, my God.
I sing praises to you with the lyre, Holy One of Israel.
23 My lips shall shout for joy!
My soul, which you have redeemed, sings praises to you!
24 My tongue will also talk about your righteousness all day long,
for they are disappointed, and they are confounded,
who want to harm me.

72

By Solomon.
1 God, give the king your justice;
your righteousness to the royal son.
2 He will judge your people with righteousness,
and your poor with justice.
3 The mountains shall bring prosperity to the people.
The hills bring the fruit of righteousness.
4 He will judge the poor of the people.
He will save the children of the needy,
and will break the oppressor in pieces.
5 They shall fear you while the sun endures;
and as long as the moon, throughout all generations.
6 He will come down like rain on the mown grass,
as showers that water the earth.
7 In his days, the righteous shall flourish,
and abundance of peace, until the moon is no more.
8 He shall have dominion also from sea to sea,
from the River to the ends of the earth.
9 Those who dwell in the wilderness shall bow before him.
His enemies shall lick the dust.
10 The kings of Tarshish and of the islands will bring tribute.
The kings of Sheba and Seba shall offer gifts.
11 Yes, all kings shall fall down before him.
All nations shall serve him.
12 For he will deliver the needy when he cries;
the poor, who has no helper.
13 He will have pity on the poor and needy.
He will save the souls of the needy.
14 He will redeem their soul from oppression and violence.
Their blood will be precious in his sight.
15 He will live; and Sheba's gold will be given to him.
Men will pray for him continually.
They will bless him all day long.
16 Abundance of grain shall be throughout the land.
Its fruit sways like Lebanon.
Let it flourish, thriving like the grass of the field.
17 His name endures forever.
His name continues as long as the sun.
Men shall be blessed by him.
All nations will call him blessed.

18 Praise be to Yahweh God, the God of Israel,
who alone does marvelous deeds.
19 Blessed be his glorious name forever!
Let the whole earth be filled with his glory!
Amen and amen.

20 This ends the prayers by David, the son of Jesse.

BOOK 3

73

A Psalm by Asaph.

† **73:1** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

1 Surely God† is good to Israel,
to those who are pure in heart.
2 But as for me, my feet were almost gone.
My steps had nearly slipped.
3 For I was envious of the arrogant,
when I saw the prosperity of the wicked.
4 For there are no struggles in their death,
but their strength is firm.
5 They are free from burdens of men,
neither are they plagued like other men.
6 Therefore pride is like a chain around their neck.
Violence covers them like a garment.
7 Their eyes bulge with fat.
Their minds pass the limits of conceit.
8 They scoff and speak with malice.
In arrogance, they threaten oppression.
9 They have set their mouth in the heavens.
Their tongue walks through the earth.
10 Therefore their people return to them,
and they drink up waters of abundance.
11 They say, “How does God know?
Is there knowledge in the Most High?”
12 Behold, these are the wicked.
Being always at ease, they increase in riches.
13 Surely I have cleansed my heart in vain,
and washed my hands in innocence,
14 For all day long I have been plagued,
and punished every morning.
15 If I had said, “I will speak thus”,
behold, I would have betrayed the generation of your children.
16 When I tried to understand this,
it was too painful for me—
17 until I entered God’s sanctuary,
and considered their latter end.
18 Surely you set them in slippery places.
You throw them down to destruction.
19 How they are suddenly destroyed!
They are completely swept away with terrors.
20 As a dream when one wakes up,
so, Lord,‡ when you awake, you will despise their fantasies.
21 For my soul was grieved.
I was embittered in my heart.
22 I was so senseless and ignorant.
I was a brute beast before you.
23 Nevertheless, I am continually with you.
You have held my right hand.
24 You will guide me with your counsel,
and afterward receive me to glory.
25 Whom do I have in heaven?
There is no one on earth whom I desire besides you.
26 My flesh and my heart fails,
but God is the strength of my heart and my portion forever.
27 For, behold, those who are far from you shall perish.
You have destroyed all those who are unfaithful to you.
28 But it is good for me to come close to God.
I have made the Lord Yahweh§ my refuge,
that I may tell of all your works.

74

A contemplation by Asaph.
1 God, why have you rejected us forever?
Why does your anger smolder against the sheep of your pasture?
2 Remember your congregation, which you purchased of old,
which you have redeemed to be the tribe of your inheritance:
Mount Zion, in which you have lived.
3 Lift up your feet to the perpetual ruins,
all the evil that the enemy has done in the sanctuary.
4 Your adversaries have roared in the middle of your assembly.
They have set up their standards as signs.
5 They behaved like men wielding axes,
cutting through a thicket of trees.
6 Now they break all its carved work down with hatchet and hammers.
7 They have burned your sanctuary to the ground.

‡ **73:20** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai.”
§ **73:28** “Yahweh” is God’s proper Name, sometimes rendered “LORD” (all caps) in other translations.

They have profaned the dwelling
place of your Name.
8 They said in their heart, “We will crush
them completely.”
They have burned up all the places in
the land where God was worshiped.
9 We see no miraculous signs.
There is no longer any prophet,
neither is there among us anyone
who knows how long.
10 How long, God, shall the adversary
reproach?
Shall the enemy blaspheme your
name forever?
11 Why do you draw back your hand, even
your right hand?
Take it from your chest and consume
them!

12 Yet God is my King of old,
working salvation throughout the
earth.
13 You divided the sea by your strength.
You broke the heads of the sea
monsters in the waters.
14 You broke the heads of Leviathan in
pieces.
You gave him as food to people and
desert creatures.
15 You opened up spring and stream.
You dried up mighty rivers.
16 The day is yours, the night is also yours.
You have prepared the light and the
sun.
17 You have set all the boundaries of the
earth.
You have made summer and winter.

18 Remember this, that the enemy has
mocked you, Yahweh.
Foolish people have blasphemed your
name.
19 Don’t deliver the soul of your dove to
wild beasts.
Don’t forget the life of your poor
forever.
20 Honor your covenant,
for haunts of violence fill the dark
places of the earth.
21 Don’t let the oppressed return ashamed.
Let the poor and needy praise your
name.
22 Arise, God! Plead your own cause.
Remember how the foolish man
mocks you all day.
23 Don’t forget the voice of your
adversaries.
The tumult of those who rise up
against you ascends continually.

75

For the Chief Musician. To the tune of “Do Not Destroy.” A Psalm by Asaph. A song.
1 We give thanks to you, God.
We give thanks, for your Name is
near.
Men tell about your wondrous works.

2 When I choose the appointed time,
I will judge blamelessly.
3 The earth and all its inhabitants quake.
I firmly hold its pillars.
Selah.
4 I said to the arrogant, “Don’t boast!”
I said to the wicked, “Don’t lift up the
horn.
5 Don’t lift up your horn on high.
Don’t speak with a stiff neck.”
6 For neither from the east, nor from the
west,
nor yet from the south, comes
exaltation.
7 But God is the judge.
He puts down one, and lifts up
another.
8 For in Yahweh’s hand there is a cup,
full of foaming wine mixed with
spices.
He pours it out.
Indeed the wicked of the earth drink
and drink it to its very dregs.

9 But I will declare this forever:
I will sing praises to the God of Jacob.
10 I will cut off all the horns of the wicked,
but the horns of the righteous shall be
lifted up.

76

For the Chief Musician. On stringed instruments. A Psalm by Asaph. A song.
1 In Judah, God is known.
His name is great in Israel.
2 His tabernacle is also in Salem.
His dwelling place in Zion.

3 There he broke the flaming arrows of the bow,
the shield, and the sword, and the weapons of war.
Selah.
4 Glorious are you, and excellent,
more than mountains of game.
5 Valiant men lie plundered,
they have slept their last sleep.
None of the men of war can lift their hands.
6 At your rebuke, God of Jacob,
both chariot and horse are cast into a dead sleep.
7 You, even you, are to be feared.
Who can stand in your sight when you are angry?
8 You pronounced judgment from heaven.
The earth feared, and was silent,
9 when God arose to judgment,
to save all the afflicted ones of the earth.
Selah.
10 Surely the wrath of man praises you.
The survivors of your wrath are restrained.
11 Make vows to Yahweh your God, and fulfill them!
Let all of his neighbors bring presents to him who is to be feared.
12 He will cut off the spirit of princes.
He is feared by the kings of the earth.

77

For the Chief Musician. To Jeduthun. A Psalm by Asaph.
1 My cry goes to God!
Indeed, I cry to God for help,
and for him to listen to me.
2 In the day of my trouble I sought the Lord.
My hand was stretched out in the night, and didn't get tired.
My soul refused to be comforted.
3 I remember God, and I groan.
I complain, and my spirit is overwhelmed.
Selah.
4 You hold my eyelids open.
I am so troubled that I can't speak.
5 I have considered the days of old,
the years of ancient times.
6 I remember my song in the night.
I consider in my own heart;
my spirit diligently inquires:
7 "Will the Lord reject us forever?
Will he be favorable no more?
8 Has his loving kindness vanished forever?
Does his promise fail for generations?
9 Has God forgotten to be gracious?
Has he, in anger, withheld his compassion?"
Selah.
10 Then I thought, "I will appeal to this:
the years of the right hand of the Most High."
11 I will remember Yah's deeds;
for I will remember your wonders of old.
12 I will also meditate on all your work,
and consider your doings.
13 Your way, God, is in the sanctuary.
What god is great like God?
14 You are the God who does wonders.
You have made your strength known among the peoples.
15 You have redeemed your people with your arm,
the sons of Jacob and Joseph.
Selah.
16 The waters saw you, God.
The waters saw you, and they writhed.
The depths also convulsed.
17 The clouds poured out water.
The skies resounded with thunder.
Your arrows also flashed around.
18 The voice of your thunder was in the whirlwind.
The lightnings lit up the world.
The earth trembled and shook.
19 Your way was through the sea,
your paths through the great waters.
Your footsteps were not known.
20 You led your people like a flock,
by the hand of Moses and Aaron.

78

A contemplation by Asaph.
1 Hear my teaching, my people.
Turn your ears to the words of my mouth.

2 I will open my mouth in a parable.
I will utter dark sayings of old,
3 which we have heard and known,
and our fathers have told us.
4 We will not hide them from their children,
telling to the generation to come the praises of Yahweh,
his strength, and his wondrous deeds that he has done.
5 For he established a covenant in Jacob,
and appointed a teaching in Israel,
which he commanded our fathers,
that they should make them known to their children;
6 that the generation to come might know,
even the children who should be born;
who should arise and tell their children,
7 that they might set their hope in God,
and not forget God's deeds,
but keep his commandments,
8 and might not be as their fathers—
a stubborn and rebellious generation,
a generation that didn't make their hearts loyal,
whose spirit was not steadfast with God.
9 The children of Ephraim, being armed and carrying bows,
turned back in the day of battle.
10 They didn't keep God's covenant,
and refused to walk in his law.
11 They forgot his doings,
his wondrous deeds that he had shown them.
12 He did marvelous things in the sight of their fathers,
in the land of Egypt, in the field of Zoan.
13 He split the sea, and caused them to pass through.
He made the waters stand as a heap.
14 In the daytime he also led them with a cloud,
and all night with a light of fire.
15 He split rocks in the wilderness,
and gave them drink abundantly as out of the depths.
16 He brought streams also out of the rock,
and caused waters to run down like rivers.
17 Yet they still went on to sin against him,
to rebel against the Most High in the desert.
18 They tempted God in their heart
by asking food according to their desire.
19 Yes, they spoke against God.
They said, "Can God prepare a table in the wilderness?
20 Behold, he struck the rock, so that waters gushed out,
and streams overflowed.
Can he give bread also?
Will he provide meat for his people?"
21 Therefore Yahweh heard, and was angry.
A fire was kindled against Jacob,
anger also went up against Israel,
22 because they didn't believe in God,
and didn't trust in his salvation.
23 Yet he commanded the skies above,
and opened the doors of heaven.
24 He rained down manna on them to eat,
and gave them food from the sky.
25 Man ate the bread of angels.
He sent them food to the full.
26 He caused the east wind to blow in the sky.
By his power he guided the south wind.
27 He also rained meat on them as the dust,
winged birds as the sand of the seas.
28 He let them fall in the middle of their camp,
around their habitations.
29 So they ate, and were well filled.
He gave them their own desire.
30 They didn't turn from their cravings.
Their food was yet in their mouths,
31 when the anger of God went up against them,
killed some of their strongest,
and struck down the young men of Israel.
32 For all this they still sinned,
and didn't believe in his wondrous works.
33 Therefore he consumed their days in vanity,
and their years in terror.
34 When he killed them, then they inquired after him.

They returned and sought God
earnestly.
35 They remembered that God was their
rock,
the Most High God, their redeemer.
36 But they flattered him with their mouth,
and lied to him with their tongue.
37 For their heart was not right with him,
neither were they faithful in his
covenant.
38 But he, being merciful, forgave iniquity,
and didn't destroy them.
Yes, many times he turned his anger
away,
and didn't stir up all his wrath.
39 He remembered that they were but
flesh,
a wind that passes away, and doesn't
come again.
40 How often they rebelled against him in
the wilderness,
and grieved him in the desert!
41 They turned again and tempted God,
and provoked the Holy One of Israel.
42 They didn't remember his hand,
nor the day when he redeemed them
from the adversary;
43 how he set his signs in Egypt,
his wonders in the field of Zoan,
44 he turned their rivers into blood,
and their streams, so that they could
not drink.
45 He sent among them swarms of flies,
which devoured them;
and frogs, which destroyed them.
46 He also gave their increase to the
caterpillar,
and their labor to the locust.
47 He destroyed their vines with hail,
their sycamore fig trees with frost.
48 He also gave over their livestock to the
hail,
and their flocks to hot thunderbolts.
49 He threw on them the fierceness of his
anger,
wrath, indignation, and trouble,
and a band of angels of evil.
50 He made a path for his anger.
He didn't spare their soul from death,
but gave their life over to the
pestilence,
51 and struck all the firstborn in Egypt,
the chief of their strength in the tents
of Ham.
52 But he led out his own people like sheep,
and guided them in the wilderness
like a flock.
53 He led them safely, so that they weren't
afraid,
but the sea overwhelmed their
enemies.
54 He brought them to the border of his
sanctuary,
to this mountain, which his right
hand had taken.
55 He also drove out the nations before
them,
allotted them for an inheritance by
line,
and made the tribes of Israel to dwell
in their tents.
56 Yet they tempted and rebelled against
the Most High God,
and didn't keep his testimonies,
57 but turned back, and dealt
treacherously like their fathers.
They were twisted like a deceitful
bow.
58 For they provoked him to anger with
their high places,
and moved him to jealousy with their
engraved images.
59 When God heard this, he was angry,
and greatly abhorred Israel,
60 so that he abandoned the tent of Shiloh,
the tent which he placed among men,
61 and delivered his strength into
captivity,
his glory into the adversary's hand.
62 He also gave his people over to the
sword,
and was angry with his inheritance.
63 Fire devoured their young men.
Their virgins had no wedding song.
64 Their priests fell by the sword,
and their widows couldn't weep.
65 Then the Lord awakened as one out of
sleep,
like a mighty man who shouts by
reason of wine.
66 He struck his adversaries backward.
He put them to a perpetual reproach.
67 Moreover he rejected the tent of Joseph,
and didn't choose the tribe of
Ephraim,

68 But chose the tribe of Judah,
Mount Zion which he loved.
69 He built his sanctuary like the heights,
like the earth which he has
established forever.
70 He also chose David his servant,
and took him from the sheepfolds;
71 from following the ewes that have their
young,
he brought him to be the shepherd of
Jacob, his people,
and Israel, his inheritance.
72 So he was their shepherd according to
the integrity of his heart,
and guided them by the skillfulness of
his hands.

79

A Psalm by Asaph.
1 God, the nations have come into your
inheritance.
They have defiled your holy temple.
They have laid Jerusalem in heaps.
2 They have given the dead bodies of your
servants to be food for the birds of
the sky,
the flesh of your saints to the animals
of the earth.
3 They have shed their blood like water
around Jerusalem.
There was no one to bury them.
4 We have become a reproach to our
neighbors,
a scoffing and derision to those who
are around us.
5 How long, Yahweh?
Will you be angry forever?
Will your jealousy burn like fire?
6 Pour out your wrath on the nations that
don't know you,
on the kingdoms that don't call on
your name,
7 for they have devoured Jacob,
and destroyed his homeland.
8 Don't hold the iniquities of our
forefathers against us.
Let your tender mercies speedily
meet us,
for we are in desperate need.
9 Help us, God of our salvation, for the
glory of your name.
Deliver us, and forgive our sins, for
your name's sake.
10 Why should the nations say, "Where is
their God?"
Let it be known among the nations,
before our eyes,
that vengeance for your servants'
blood is being poured out.
11 Let the sighing of the prisoner come
before you.
According to the greatness of your
power, preserve those who are
sentenced to death.
12 Pay back to our neighbors seven times
into their bosom
their reproach with which they have
reproached you, Lord.
13 So we, your people and sheep of your
pasture,
will give you thanks forever.
We will praise you forever, to all
generations.

80

For the Chief Musician. To the tune of "The Lilies of the Covenant." A Psalm by Asaph.
1 Hear us, Shepherd of Israel,
you who lead Joseph like a flock,
you who sit above the cherubim,
shine out.
2 Before Ephraim, Benjamin, and
Manasseh, stir up your might!
Come to save us!
3 Turn us again, God.
Cause your face to shine,
and we will be saved.

4 Yahweh God of Armies,
how long will you be angry against
the prayer of your people?
5 You have fed them with the bread of
tears,
and given them tears to drink in large
measure.
6 You make us a source of contention to
our neighbors.
Our enemies laugh among
themselves.
7 Turn us again, God of Armies.
Cause your face to shine,
and we will be saved.

8 You brought a vine out of Egypt.

You drove out the nations, and
planted it.
9 You cleared the ground for it.
It took deep root, and filled the land.
10 The mountains were covered with its
shadow.
Its boughs were like God's cedars.
11 It sent out its branches to the sea,
its shoots to the River.
12 Why have you broken down its walls,
so that all those who pass by the way
pluck it?
13 The boar out of the wood ravages it.
The wild animals of the field feed on
it.
14 Turn again, we beg you, God of Armies.
Look down from heaven, and see, and
visit this vine,
15 the stock which your right hand
planted,
the branch that you made strong for
yourself.
16 It's burned with fire.
It's cut down.
They perish at your rebuke.
17 Let your hand be on the man of your
right hand,
on the son of man whom you made
strong for yourself.
18 So we will not turn away from you.
Revive us, and we will call on your
name.
19 Turn us again, Yahweh God of Armies.
Cause your face to shine, and we will
be saved.

81

For the Chief Musician. On an instrument of Gath. By Asaph.
1 Sing aloud to God, our strength!
Make a joyful shout to the God of
Jacob!
2 Raise a song, and bring here the
tambourine,
the pleasant lyre with the harp.
3 Blow the trumpet at the New Moon,
at the full moon, on our feast day.
4 For it is a statute for Israel,
an ordinance of the God of Jacob.
5 He appointed it in Joseph for a covenant,
when he went out over the land of
Egypt,
I heard a language that I didn't know.
6 "I removed his shoulder from the
burden.
His hands were freed from the basket.
7 You called in trouble, and I delivered
you.
I answered you in the secret place of
thunder.
I tested you at the waters of Meribah."
Selah.

8 "Hear, my people, and I will testify to you,
Israel, if you would listen to me!
9 There shall be no strange god in you,
neither shall you worship any foreign
god.
10 I am Yahweh, your God,
who brought you up out of the land of
Egypt.
Open your mouth wide, and I will fill
it.
11 But my people didn't listen to my voice.
Israel desired none of me.
12 So I let them go after the stubbornness
of their hearts,
that they might walk in their own
counsels.
13 Oh that my people would listen to me,
that Israel would walk in my ways!
14 I would soon subdue their enemies,
and turn my hand against their
adversaries.
15 The haters of Yahweh would cringe
before him,
and their punishment would last
forever.
16 But he would have also fed them with
the finest of the wheat.
I will satisfy you with honey out of the
rock."

82

A Psalm by Asaph.
1 God presides in the great assembly.
He judges among the gods.
2 "How long will you judge unjustly,
and show partiality to the wicked?"
Selah.

3 "Defend the weak, the poor, and the
fatherless.
Maintain the rights of the poor and
oppressed.
4 Rescue the weak and needy.

Deliver them out of the hand of the
wicked."
5 They don't know, neither do they
understand.
They walk back and forth in darkness.
All the foundations of the earth are
shaken.
6 I said, "You are gods,
all of you are sons of the Most High.
7 Nevertheless you shall die like men,
and fall like one of the rulers."
8 Arise, God, judge the earth,
for you inherit all of the nations.

83

A song. A Psalm by Asaph.
1 God, don't keep silent.
Don't keep silent,
and don't be still, God.
2 For, behold, your enemies are stirred up.
Those who hate you have lifted up
their heads.
3 They conspire with cunning against your
people.
They plot against your cherished
ones.
4 "Come," they say, "let's destroy them as a
nation,
that the name of Israel may be
remembered no more."
5 For they have conspired together with
one mind.
They form an alliance against you.
6 The tents of Edom and the Ishmaelites;
Moab, and the Hagrites;
7 Gebal, Ammon, and Amalek;
Philistia with the inhabitants of Tyre;
8 Assyria also is joined with them.
They have helped the children of Lot.
Selah.
9 Do to them as you did to Midian,
as to Sisera, as to Jabin, at the river
Kishon;
10 who perished at Endor,
who became as dung for the earth.
11 Make their nobles like Oreb and Zeeb,
yes, all their princes like Zebah and
Zalmunna,
12 who said, "Let's take possession of
God's pasture lands."
13 My God, make them like tumbleweed,
like chaff before the wind.
14 As the fire that burns the forest,
as the flame that sets the mountains
on fire,
15 so pursue them with your tempest,
and terrify them with your storm.
16 Fill their faces with confusion,
that they may seek your name,
Yahweh.
17 Let them be disappointed and dismayed
forever.
Yes, let them be confounded and
perish;
18 that they may know that you alone,
whose name is Yahweh,
are the Most High over all the earth.

84

For the Chief Musician. On an instrument
of Gath. A Psalm by the sons of Korah.
1 How lovely are your dwellings,
Yahweh of Armies!
2 My soul longs, and even faints for the
courts of Yahweh.
My heart and my flesh cry out for the
living God.
3 Yes, the sparrow has found a home,
and the swallow a nest for herself,
where she may have her young,
near your altars, Yahweh of Armies,
my King, and my God.
4 Blessed are those who dwell in your
house.
They are always praising you.
Selah.
5 Blessed are those whose strength is in
you,
who have set their hearts on a
pilgrimage.
6 Passing through the valley of Weeping,
they make it a place of springs.
Yes, the autumn rain covers it with
blessings.
7 They go from strength to strength.
Every one of them appears before
God in Zion.
8 Yahweh, God of Armies, hear my prayer.
Listen, God of Jacob.
Selah.
9 Behold, God our shield,
look at the face of your anointed.
10 For a day in your courts is better than a
thousand.
I would rather be a doorkeeper in the
house of my God,

than to dwell in the tents of
wickedness.
11 For Yahweh God is a sun and a shield.
Yahweh will give grace and glory.
He withholds no good thing from
those who walk blamelessly.
12 Yahweh of Armies,
blessed is the man who trusts in you.

85

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by the sons of Korah.
1 Yahweh, you have been favorable to
your land.
You have restored the fortunes of
Jacob.
2 You have forgiven the iniquity of your
people.
You have covered all their sin.
Selah.
3 You have taken away all your wrath.
You have turned from the fierceness
of your anger.
4 Turn us, God of our salvation,
and cause your indignation toward us
to cease.
5 Will you be angry with us forever?
Will you draw out your anger to all
generations?
6 Won't you revive us again,
that your people may rejoice in you?
7 Show us your loving kindness, Yahweh.
Grant us your salvation.
8 I will hear what God, Yahweh, will speak,
for he will speak peace to his people,
his saints;
but let them not turn again to folly.
9 Surely his salvation is near those who
fear him,
that glory may dwell in our land.
10 Mercy and truth meet together.
Righteousness and peace have kissed
each other.
11 Truth springs out of the earth.
Righteousness has looked down from
heaven.
12 Yes, Yahweh will give that which is
good.
Our land will yield its increase.
13 Righteousness goes before him,
and prepares the way for his steps.

86

A Prayer by David.
1 Hear, Yahweh, and answer me,
for I am poor and needy.
2 Preserve my soul, for I am godly.
You, my God, save your servant who
trusts in you.
3 Be merciful to me, Lord,
for I call to you all day long.
4 Bring joy to the soul of your servant,
for to you, Lord, do I lift up my soul.
5 For you, Lord, are good, and ready to
forgive,
abundant in loving kindness to all
those who call on you.
6 Hear, Yahweh, my prayer.
Listen to the voice of my petitions.
7 In the day of my trouble I will call on you,
for you will answer me.
8 There is no one like you among the gods,
Lord,
nor any deeds like your deeds.
9 All nations you have made will come and
worship before you, Lord.
They shall glorify your name.
10 For you are great, and do wondrous
things.
You are God alone.
11 Teach me your way, Yahweh.
I will walk in your truth.
Make my heart undivided to fear
your name.
12 I will praise you, Lord my God, with my
whole heart.
I will glorify your name forever more.
13 For your loving kindness is great
toward me.
You have delivered my soul from the
lowest Sheol.†
14 God, the proud have risen up against
me.
A company of violent men have
sought after my soul,
and they don't hold regard for you
before them.
15 But you, Lord, are a merciful and
gracious God,
slow to anger, and abundant in loving
kindness and truth.
16 Turn to me, and have mercy on me!
Give your strength to your servant.

† **86:13** Sheol is the place of the dead.

Save the son of your servant.
17 Show me a sign of your goodness,
that those who hate me may see it,
and be shamed,
because you, Yahweh, have helped
me, and comforted me.

87

A Psalm by the sons of Korah; a Song.
1 His foundation is in the holy mountains.
2 Yahweh loves the gates of Zion more
than all the dwellings of Jacob.
3 Glorious things are spoken about you,
city of God.
Selah.
4 I will record Rahab† and Babylon among
those who acknowledge me.
Behold, Philistia, Tyre, and also
Ethiopia:
"This one was born there."
5 Yes, of Zion it will be said, "This one and
that one was born in her;"
the Most High himself will establish
her.
6 Yahweh will count, when he writes up
the peoples,
"This one was born there."
Selah.
7 Those who sing as well as those who
dance say,
"All my springs are in you."

88

A Song. A Psalm by the sons of Korah. For the Chief Musician. To the tune of "The Suffering of Affliction." A contemplation by Heman, the Ezrahite.
1 Yahweh, the God of my salvation,
I have cried day and night before you.
2 Let my prayer enter into your presence.
Turn your ear to my cry.
3 For my soul is full of troubles.
My life draws near to Sheol.†
4 I am counted among those who go down
into the pit.
I am like a man who has no help,
5 set apart among the dead,
like the slain who lie in the grave,
whom you remember no more.
They are cut off from your hand.
6 You have laid me in the lowest pit,
in the darkest depths.
7 Your wrath lies heavily on me.
You have afflicted me with all your
waves.
Selah.
8 You have taken my friends from me.
You have made me an abomination to
them.
I am confined, and I can't escape.
9 My eyes are dim from grief.
I have called on you daily, Yahweh.
I have spread out my hands to you.
10 Do you show wonders to the dead?
Do the departed spirits rise up and
praise you?
Selah.
11 Is your loving kindness declared in the
grave?
Or your faithfulness in Destruction?
12 Are your wonders made known in the
dark?
Or your righteousness in the land of
forgetfulness?
13 But to you, Yahweh, I have cried.
In the morning, my prayer comes
before you.
14 Yahweh, why do you reject my soul?
Why do you hide your face from me?
15 I am afflicted and ready to die from my
youth up.
While I suffer your terrors, I am
distracted.
16 Your fierce wrath has gone over me.
Your terrors have cut me off.
17 They came around me like water all day
long.
They completely engulfed me.
18 You have put lover and friend far from
me,
and my friends into darkness.

89

A contemplation by Ethan, the Ezrahite.
1 I will sing of the loving kindness of
Yahweh forever.
With my mouth, I will make known
your faithfulness to all generations.
2 I indeed declare, "Love stands firm
forever.
You established the heavens.
Your faithfulness is in them."

† **87:4** Rahab is a reference to Egypt. † **88:3** Sheol is the place of the dead.

3 “I have made a covenant with my chosen one,
I have sworn to David, my servant,
4 ‘I will establish your offspring forever,
and build up your throne to all generations.’ ”
Selah.
5 The heavens will praise your wonders, Yahweh,
your faithfulness also in the assembly of the holy ones.
6 For who in the skies can be compared to Yahweh?
Who among the sons of the heavenly beings is like Yahweh,
7 a very awesome God in the council of the holy ones,
to be feared above all those who are around him?
8 Yahweh, God of Armies, who is a mighty one, like you?
Yah, your faithfulness is around you.
9 You rule the pride of the sea.
When its waves rise up, you calm them.
10 You have broken Rahab in pieces, like one of the slain.
You have scattered your enemies with your mighty arm.
11 The heavens are yours.
The earth also is yours,
the world and its fullness.
You have founded them.
12 You have created the north and the south.
Tabor and Hermon rejoice in your name.
13 You have a mighty arm.
Your hand is strong, and your right hand is exalted.
14 Righteousness and justice are the foundation of your throne.
Loving kindness and truth go before your face.
15 Blessed are the people who learn to acclaim you.
They walk in the light of your presence, Yahweh.
16 In your name they rejoice all day.
In your righteousness, they are exalted.
17 For you are the glory of their strength.
In your favor, our horn will be exalted.
18 For our shield belongs to Yahweh,
our king to the Holy One of Israel.

19 Then you spoke in vision to your saints,
and said, “I have given strength to the warrior.
I have exalted a young man from the people.
20 I have found David, my servant.
I have anointed him with my holy oil,
21 with whom my hand shall be established.
My arm will also strengthen him.
22 No enemy will tax him.
No wicked man will oppress him.
23 I will beat down his adversaries before him,
and strike those who hate him.
24 But my faithfulness and my loving kindness will be with him.
In my name, his horn will be exalted.
25 I will set his hand also on the sea,
and his right hand on the rivers.
26 He will call to me, ‘You are my Father,
my God, and the rock of my salvation!’
27 I will also appoint him my firstborn,
the highest of the kings of the earth.
28 I will keep my loving kindness for him forever more.
My covenant will stand firm with him.
29 I will also make his offspring endure forever,
and his throne as the days of heaven.
30 If his children forsake my law,
and don’t walk in my ordinances;
31 if they break my statutes,
and don’t keep my commandments;
32 then I will punish their sin with the rod,
and their iniquity with stripes.
33 But I will not completely take my loving kindness from him,
nor allow my faithfulness to fail.
34 I will not break my covenant,
nor alter what my lips have uttered.
35 Once I have sworn by my holiness,
I will not lie to David.
36 His offspring will endure forever,
his throne like the sun before me.

37 It will be established forever like the moon,
the faithful witness in the sky."
Selah.

38 But you have rejected and spurned.
You have been angry with your anointed.
39 You have renounced the covenant of your servant.
You have defiled his crown in the dust.
40 You have broken down all his hedges.
You have brought his strongholds to ruin.
41 All who pass by the way rob him.
He has become a reproach to his neighbors.
42 You have exalted the right hand of his adversaries.
You have made all of his enemies rejoice.
43 Yes, you turn back the edge of his sword,
and haven't supported him in battle.
44 You have ended his splendor,
and thrown his throne down to the ground.
45 You have shortened the days of his youth.
You have covered him with shame.
Selah.
46 How long, Yahweh?
Will you hide yourself forever?
Will your wrath burn like fire?
47 Remember how short my time is,
for what vanity you have created all the children of men!
48 What man is he who shall live and not see death,
who shall deliver his soul from the power of Sheol?†
Selah.
49 Lord, where are your former loving kindnesses,
which you swore to David in your faithfulness?
50 Remember, Lord, the reproach of your servants,
how I bear in my heart the taunts of all the mighty peoples,
51 With which your enemies have mocked, Yahweh,
with which they have mocked the footsteps of your anointed one.

52 Blessed be Yahweh forever more.
Amen, and Amen.

BOOK 4

90

A Prayer by Moses, the man of God.†
1 Lord,‡ you have been our dwelling place for all generations.
2 Before the mountains were born,
before you had formed the earth and the world,
even from everlasting to everlasting, you are God.
3 You turn man to destruction, saying,
"Return, you children of men."
4 For a thousand years in your sight are just like yesterday when it is past,
like a watch in the night.
5 You sweep them away as they sleep.
In the morning they sprout like new grass.
6 In the morning it sprouts and springs up.
By evening, it is withered and dry.
7 For we are consumed in your anger.
We are troubled in your wrath.
8 You have set our iniquities before you,
our secret sins in the light of your presence.
9 For all our days have passed away in your wrath.
We bring our years to an end as a sigh.
10 The days of our years are seventy,
or even by reason of strength eighty years;
yet their pride is but labor and sorrow,
for it passes quickly, and we fly away.
11 Who knows the power of your anger,
your wrath according to the fear that is due to you?
12 So teach us to count our days,
that we may gain a heart of wisdom.
13 Relent, Yahweh!§
How long?

† **89:48** Sheol is the place of the dead. † **90:** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). ‡ **90:1** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." § **90:13** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations.

Have compassion on your servants!
14 Satisfy us in the morning with your loving kindness,
that we may rejoice and be glad all our days.
15 Make us glad for as many days as you have afflicted us,
for as many years as we have seen evil.
16 Let your work appear to your servants,
your glory to their children.
17 Let the favor of the Lord our God be on us.
Establish the work of our hands for us.
Yes, establish the work of our hands.

91

1 He who dwells in the secret place of the Most High
will rest in the shadow of the Almighty.
2 I will say of Yahweh, "He is my refuge and my fortress;
my God, in whom I trust."
3 For he will deliver you from the snare of the fowler,
and from the deadly pestilence.
4 He will cover you with his feathers.
Under his wings you will take refuge.
His faithfulness is your shield and rampart.
5 You shall not be afraid of the terror by night,
nor of the arrow that flies by day,
6 nor of the pestilence that walks in darkness,
nor of the destruction that wastes at noonday.
7 A thousand may fall at your side,
and ten thousand at your right hand;
but it will not come near you.
8 You will only look with your eyes,
and see the recompense of the wicked.
9 Because you have made Yahweh your refuge,
and the Most High your dwelling place,
10 no evil shall happen to you,
neither shall any plague come near your dwelling.
11 For he will put his angels in charge of you,
to guard you in all your ways.
12 They will bear you up in their hands,
so that you won't dash your foot against a stone.
13 You will tread on the lion and cobra.
You will trample the young lion and the serpent underfoot.
14 "Because he has set his love on me, therefore I will deliver him.
I will set him on high, because he has known my name.
15 He will call on me, and I will answer him.
I will be with him in trouble.
I will deliver him, and honor him.
16 I will satisfy him with long life,
and show him my salvation."

92

A Psalm. A song for the Sabbath day.
1 It is a good thing to give thanks to Yahweh,
to sing praises to your name, Most High,
2 to proclaim your loving kindness in the morning,
and your faithfulness every night,
3 with the ten-stringed lute, with the harp,
and with the melody of the lyre.
4 For you, Yahweh, have made me glad through your work.
I will triumph in the works of your hands.
5 How great are your works, Yahweh!
Your thoughts are very deep.
6 A senseless man doesn't know,
neither does a fool understand this:
7 though the wicked spring up as the grass,
and all the evildoers flourish,
they will be destroyed forever.
8 But you, Yahweh, are on high forever more.
9 For behold, your enemies, Yahweh,
for behold, your enemies shall perish.
All the evildoers will be scattered.
10 But you have exalted my horn like that of the wild ox.
I am anointed with fresh oil.
11 My eye has also seen my enemies.
My ears have heard of the wicked enemies who rise up against me.

12 The righteous shall flourish like the
palm tree.
He will grow like a cedar in Lebanon.
13 They are planted in Yahweh's house.
They will flourish in our God's courts.
14 They will still produce fruit in old age.
They will be full of sap and green,
15 to show that Yahweh is upright.
He is my rock,
and there is no unrighteousness in
him.

93

1 Yahweh reigns!
He is clothed with majesty!
Yahweh is armed with strength.
The world also is established.
It can't be moved.
2 Your throne is established from long ago.
You are from everlasting.
3 The floods have lifted up, Yahweh,
the floods have lifted up their voice.
The floods lift up their waves.
4 Above the voices of many waters,
the mighty breakers of the sea,
Yahweh on high is mighty.
5 Your statutes stand firm.
Holiness adorns your house,
Yahweh, forever more.

94

1 Yahweh, you God to whom vengeance
belongs,
you God to whom vengeance belongs,
shine out.
2 Rise up, you judge of the earth.
Pay back the proud what they
deserve.
3 Yahweh, how long will the wicked,
how long will the wicked triumph?
4 They pour out arrogant words.
All the evildoers boast.
5 They break your people in pieces,
Yahweh,
and afflict your heritage.
6 They kill the widow and the alien,
and murder the fatherless.
7 They say, "Yah will not see,
neither will Jacob's God consider."
8 Consider, you senseless among the
people;
you fools, when will you be wise?
9 He who implanted the ear, won't he
hear?
He who formed the eye, won't he see?
10 He who disciplines the nations, won't
he punish?
He who teaches man knows.
11 Yahweh knows the thoughts of man,
that they are futile.
12 Blessed is the man whom you
discipline, Yah,
and teach out of your law,
13 that you may give him rest from the
days of adversity,
until the pit is dug for the wicked.
14 For Yahweh won't reject his people,
neither will he forsake his
inheritance.
15 For judgment will return to
righteousness.
All the upright in heart shall follow it.
16 Who will rise up for me against the
wicked?
Who will stand up for me against the
evildoers?
17 Unless Yahweh had been my help,
my soul would have soon lived in
silence.
18 When I said, "My foot is slipping!"
Your loving kindness, Yahweh, held
me up.
19 In the multitude of my thoughts within
me,
your comforts delight my soul.
20 Shall the throne of wickedness have
fellowship with you,
which brings about mischief by
statute?
21 They gather themselves together
against the soul of the righteous,
and condemn the innocent blood.
22 But Yahweh has been my high tower,
my God, the rock of my refuge.
23 He has brought on them their own
iniquity,
and will cut them off in their own
wickedness.
Yahweh, our God, will cut them off.

95

1 Oh come, let's sing to Yahweh.
Let's shout aloud to the rock of our
salvation!

2 Let's come before his presence with
thanksgiving.
Let's extol him with songs!
3 For Yahweh is a great God,
a great King above all gods.
4 In his hand are the deep places of the
earth.
The heights of the mountains are also
his.
5 The sea is his, and he made it.
His hands formed the dry land.
6 Oh come, let's worship and bow down.
Let's kneel before Yahweh, our
Maker,
7 for he is our God.
We are the people of his pasture,
and the sheep in his care.
Today, oh that you would hear his voice!
8 Don't harden your heart, as at
Meribah,
as in the day of Massah in the
wilderness,
9 when your fathers tempted me,
tested me, and saw my work.
10 Forty long years I was grieved with that
generation,
and said, "They are a people who err
in their heart.
They have not known my ways."
11 Therefore I swore in my wrath,
"They won't enter into my rest."

96

1 Sing to Yahweh a new song!
Sing to Yahweh, all the earth.
2 Sing to Yahweh!
Bless his name!
Proclaim his salvation from day to
day!
3 Declare his glory among the nations,
his marvelous works among all the
peoples.
4 For Yahweh is great, and greatly to be
praised!
He is to be feared above all gods.
5 For all the gods of the peoples are idols,
but Yahweh made the heavens.
6 Honor and majesty are before him.
Strength and beauty are in his
sanctuary.
7 Ascribe to Yahweh, you families of
nations,
ascribe to Yahweh glory and strength.
8 Ascribe to Yahweh the glory due to his
name.
Bring an offering, and come into his
courts.
9 Worship Yahweh in holy array.
Tremble before him, all the earth.
10 Say among the nations, "Yahweh
reigns."
The world is also established.
It can't be moved.
He will judge the peoples with equity.
11 Let the heavens be glad, and let the
earth rejoice.
Let the sea roar, and its fullness!
12 Let the field and all that is in it
exult!
Then all the trees of the woods shall
sing for joy
13 before Yahweh; for he comes,
for he comes to judge the earth.
He will judge the world with
righteousness,
the peoples with his truth.

97

1 Yahweh reigns!
Let the earth rejoice!
Let the multitude of islands be glad!
2 Clouds and darkness are around him.
Righteousness and justice are the
foundation of his throne.
3 A fire goes before him,
and burns up his adversaries on
every side.
4 His lightning lights up the world.
The earth sees, and trembles.
5 The mountains melt like wax at the
presence of Yahweh,
at the presence of the Lord of the
whole earth.
6 The heavens declare his righteousness.
All the peoples have seen his glory.
7 Let all them be shamed who serve
engraved images,
who boast in their idols.
Worship him, all you gods![†]
8 Zion heard and was glad.
The daughters of Judah rejoiced
because of your judgments, Yahweh.

[†] **97:7** LXX reads "angels" instead of "gods".

9 For you, Yahweh, are most high above all the earth.
You are exalted far above all gods.
10 You who love Yahweh, hate evil!
He preserves the souls of his saints.
He delivers them out of the hand of the wicked.
11 Light is sown for the righteous,
and gladness for the upright in heart.
12 Be glad in Yahweh, you righteous people!
Give thanks to his holy Name.

98

A Psalm.
1 Sing to Yahweh a new song,
for he has done marvelous things!
His right hand and his holy arm have worked salvation for him.
2 Yahweh has made known his salvation.
He has openly shown his righteousness in the sight of the nations.
3 He has remembered his loving kindness and his faithfulness toward the house of Israel.
All the ends of the earth have seen the salvation of our God.
4 Make a joyful noise to Yahweh, all the earth!
Burst out and sing for joy, yes, sing praises!
5 Sing praises to Yahweh with the harp,
with the harp and the voice of melody.
6 With trumpets and sound of the ram's horn,
make a joyful noise before the King, Yahweh.
7 Let the sea roar with its fullness;
the world, and those who dwell therein.
8 Let the rivers clap their hands.
Let the mountains sing for joy together.
9 Let them sing before Yahweh,
for he comes to judge the earth.
He will judge the world with righteousness,
and the peoples with equity.

99

1 Yahweh reigns! Let the peoples tremble.
He sits enthroned among the cherubim.
Let the earth be moved.
2 Yahweh is great in Zion.
He is high above all the peoples.
3 Let them praise your great and awesome name.
He is Holy!

4 The King's strength also loves justice.
You establish equity.
You execute justice and righteousness in Jacob.
5 Exalt Yahweh our God.
Worship at his footstool.
He is Holy!

6 Moses and Aaron were among his priests,
Samuel was among those who call on his name.
They called on Yahweh, and he answered them.
7 He spoke to them in the pillar of cloud.
They kept his testimonies,
the statute that he gave them.
8 You answered them, Yahweh our God.
You are a God who forgave them,
although you took vengeance for their doings.
9 Exalt Yahweh, our God.
Worship at his holy hill,
for Yahweh, our God, is holy!

100

A Psalm of thanksgiving.
1 Shout for joy to Yahweh, all you lands!
2 Serve Yahweh with gladness.
Come before his presence with singing.
3 Know that Yahweh, he is God.
It is he who has made us, and we are his.
We are his people, and the sheep of his pasture.
4 Enter into his gates with thanksgiving,
and into his courts with praise.
Give thanks to him, and bless his name.
5 For Yahweh is good.
His loving kindness endures forever,
his faithfulness to all generations.

101

A Psalm by David.

1 I will sing of loving kindness and justice.
To you, Yahweh, I will sing praises.
2 I will be careful to live a blameless life.
When will you come to me?
I will walk within my house with a blameless heart.
3 I will set no vile thing before my eyes.
I hate the deeds of faithless men.
They will not cling to me.
4 A perverse heart will be far from me.
I will have nothing to do with evil.
5 I will silence whoever secretly slanders his neighbor.
I won't tolerate one who is arrogant and conceited.
6 My eyes will be on the faithful of the land,
that they may dwell with me.
He who walks in a perfect way,
he will serve me.
7 He who practices deceit won't dwell within my house.
He who speaks falsehood won't be established before my eyes.
8 Morning by morning, I will destroy all the wicked of the land,
to cut off all the workers of iniquity from Yahweh's city.

102

A Prayer of the afflicted, when he is overwhelmed and pours out his complaint before Yahweh.

1 Hear my prayer, Yahweh!
Let my cry come to you.
2 Don't hide your face from me in the day of my distress.
Turn your ear to me.
Answer me quickly in the day when I call.
3 For my days consume away like smoke.
My bones are burned as a torch.
4 My heart is blighted like grass, and withered,
for I forget to eat my bread.
5 By reason of the voice of my groaning,
my bones stick to my skin.
6 I am like a pelican of the wilderness.
I have become as an owl of the waste places.
7 I watch, and have become like a sparrow that is alone on the housetop.
8 My enemies reproach me all day.
Those who are mad at me use my name as a curse.
9 For I have eaten ashes like bread,
and mixed my drink with tears,
10 because of your indignation and your wrath;
for you have taken me up and thrown me away.
11 My days are like a long shadow.
I have withered like grass.

12 But you, Yahweh, will remain forever;
your renown endures to all generations.
13 You will arise and have mercy on Zion,
for it is time to have pity on her.
Yes, the set time has come.
14 For your servants take pleasure in her stones,
and have pity on her dust.
15 So the nations will fear Yahweh's name,
all the kings of the earth your glory.
16 For Yahweh has built up Zion.
He has appeared in his glory.
17 He has responded to the prayer of the destitute,
and has not despised their prayer.
18 This will be written for the generation to come.
A people which will be created will praise Yah,
19 for he has looked down from the height of his sanctuary.
From heaven, Yahweh saw the earth,
20 to hear the groans of the prisoner,
to free those who are condemned to death,
21 that men may declare Yahweh's name in Zion,
and his praise in Jerusalem,
22 when the peoples are gathered together,
the kingdoms, to serve Yahweh.

23 He weakened my strength along the course.
He shortened my days.
24 I said, "My God, don't take me away in the middle of my days.

Your years are throughout all
generations.
25 Of old, you laid the foundation of the
earth.
The heavens are the work of your
hands.
26 They will perish, but you will endure.
Yes, all of them will wear out like a
garment.
You will change them like a cloak, and
they will be changed.
27 But you are the same.
Your years will have no end.
28 The children of your servants will
continue.
Their offspring will be established
before you."

103

By David.
1 Praise Yahweh, my soul!
All that is within me, praise his holy
name!
2 Praise Yahweh, my soul,
and don't forget all his benefits,
3 who forgives all your sins,
who heals all your diseases,
4 who redeems your life from destruction,
who crowns you with loving kindness
and tender mercies,
5 who satisfies your desire with good
things,
so that your youth is renewed like the
eagle's.
6 Yahweh executes righteous acts,
and justice for all who are oppressed.
7 He made known his ways to Moses,
his deeds to the children of Israel.
8 Yahweh is merciful and gracious,
slow to anger, and abundant in loving
kindness.
9 He will not always accuse;
neither will he stay angry forever.
10 He has not dealt with us according to
our sins,
nor repaid us for our iniquities.
11 For as the heavens are high above the
earth,
so great is his loving kindness toward
those who fear him.
12 As far as the east is from the west,
so far has he removed our
transgressions from us.
13 Like a father has compassion on his
children,
so Yahweh has compassion on those
who fear him.
14 For he knows how we are made.
He remembers that we are dust.
15 As for man, his days are like grass.
As a flower of the field, so he
flourishes.
16 For the wind passes over it, and it is
gone.
Its place remembers it no more.
17 But Yahweh's loving kindness is from
everlasting to everlasting with
those who fear him,
his righteousness to children's
children,
18 to those who keep his covenant,
to those who remember to obey his
precepts.
19 Yahweh has established his throne in
the heavens.
His kingdom rules over all.
20 Praise Yahweh, you angels of his,
who are mighty in strength, who
fulfill his word,
obeying the voice of his word.
21 Praise Yahweh, all you armies of his,
you servants of his, who do his
pleasure.
22 Praise Yahweh, all you works of his,
in all places of his dominion.
Praise Yahweh, my soul!

104

1 Bless Yahweh, my soul.
Yahweh, my God, you are very great.
You are clothed with honor and
majesty.
2 He covers himself with light as with a
garment.
He stretches out the heavens like a
curtain.
3 He lays the beams of his rooms in the
waters.
He makes the clouds his chariot.
He walks on the wings of the wind.
4 He makes his messengers† winds,
and his servants flames of fire.
5 He laid the foundations of the earth,
that it should not be moved forever.

† **104:4** or, angels

6 You covered it with the deep as with a
cloak.
The waters stood above the
mountains.
7 At your rebuke they fled.
At the voice of your thunder they
hurried away.
8 The mountains rose,
the valleys sank down,
to the place which you had assigned
to them.
9 You have set a boundary that they may
not pass over,
that they don't turn again to cover the
earth.
10 He sends springs into the valleys.
They run among the mountains.
11 They give drink to every animal of the
field.
The wild donkeys quench their thirst.
12 The birds of the sky nest by them.
They sing among the branches.
13 He waters the mountains from his
rooms.
The earth is filled with the fruit of
your works.
14 He causes the grass to grow for the
livestock,
and plants for man to cultivate,
that he may produce food out of the
earth:
15 wine that makes the heart of man glad,
oil to make his face to shine,
and bread that strengthens man's
heart.
16 Yahweh's trees are well watered,
the cedars of Lebanon, which he has
planted,
17 where the birds make their nests.
The stork makes its home in the
cypress trees.
18 The high mountains are for the wild
goats.
The rocks are a refuge for the rock
badgers.
19 He appointed the moon for seasons.
The sun knows when to set.
20 You make darkness, and it is night,
in which all the animals of the forest
prowl.
21 The young lions roar after their prey,
and seek their food from God.
22 The sun rises, and they steal away,
and lie down in their dens.
23 Man goes out to his work,
to his labor until the evening.
24 Yahweh, how many are your works!
In wisdom, you have made them all.
The earth is full of your riches.
25 There is the sea, great and wide,
in which are innumerable living
things,
both small and large animals.
26 There the ships go,
and leviathan, whom you formed to
play there.
27 These all wait for you,
that you may give them their food in
due season.
28 You give to them; they gather.
You open your hand; they are
satisfied with good.
29 You hide your face; they are troubled.
You take away their breath; they die
and return to the dust.
30 You send out your Spirit and they are
created.
You renew the face of the ground.
31 Let Yahweh's glory endure forever.
Let Yahweh rejoice in his works.
32 He looks at the earth, and it trembles.
He touches the mountains, and they
smoke.
33 I will sing to Yahweh as long as I live.
I will sing praise to my God while I
have any being.
34 Let my meditation be sweet to him.
I will rejoice in Yahweh.
35 Let sinners be consumed out of the
earth.
Let the wicked be no more.
Bless Yahweh, my soul.
Praise Yah!

105

1 Give thanks to Yahweh! Call on his
name!
Make his doings known among the
peoples.
2 Sing to him, sing praises to him!
Tell of all his marvelous works.
3 Glory in his holy name.
Let the heart of those who seek
Yahweh rejoice.
4 Seek Yahweh and his strength.
Seek his face forever more.

5 Remember his marvelous works that he has done:
his wonders, and the judgments of his mouth,
6 you offspring of Abraham, his servant,
you children of Jacob, his chosen ones.
7 He is Yahweh, our God.
His judgments are in all the earth.
8 He has remembered his covenant forever,
the word which he commanded to a thousand generations,
9 the covenant which he made with Abraham,
his oath to Isaac,
10 and confirmed it to Jacob for a statute;
to Israel for an everlasting covenant,
11 saying, “To you I will give the land of Canaan,
the lot of your inheritance,”
12 when they were but a few men in number,
yes, very few, and foreigners in it.
13 They went about from nation to nation,
from one kingdom to another people.
14 He allowed no one to do them wrong.
Yes, he reproved kings for their sakes,
15 “Don’t touch my anointed ones!
Do my prophets no harm!”
16 He called for a famine on the land.
He destroyed the food supplies.
17 He sent a man before them.
Joseph was sold for a slave.
18 They bruised his feet with shackles.
His neck was locked in irons,
19 until the time that his word happened,
and Yahweh’s word proved him true.
20 The king sent and freed him,
even the ruler of peoples, and let him go free.
21 He made him lord of his house,
and ruler of all of his possessions,
22 to discipline his princes at his pleasure,
and to teach his elders wisdom.
23 Israel also came into Egypt.
Jacob lived in the land of Ham.
24 He increased his people greatly,
and made them stronger than their adversaries.
25 He turned their heart to hate his people,
to conspire against his servants.
26 He sent Moses, his servant,
and Aaron, whom he had chosen.
27 They performed miracles among them,
and wonders in the land of Ham.
28 He sent darkness, and made it dark.
They didn’t rebel against his words.
29 He turned their waters into blood,
and killed their fish.
30 Their land swarmed with frogs,
even in the rooms of their kings.
31 He spoke, and swarms of flies came,
and lice in all their borders.
32 He gave them hail for rain,
with lightning in their land.
33 He struck their vines and also their fig trees,
and shattered the trees of their country.
34 He spoke, and the locusts came
with the grasshoppers, without number.
35 They ate up every plant in their land,
and ate up the fruit of their ground.
36 He struck also all the firstborn in their land,
the first fruits of all their manhood.
37 He brought them out with silver and gold.
There was not one feeble person among his tribes.
38 Egypt was glad when they departed,
for the fear of them had fallen on them.
39 He spread a cloud for a covering,
fire to give light in the night.
40 They asked, and he brought quails,
and satisfied them with the bread of the sky.
41 He opened the rock, and waters gushed out.
They ran as a river in the dry places.
42 For he remembered his holy word,
and Abraham, his servant.
43 He brought his people out with joy,
his chosen with singing.
44 He gave them the lands of the nations.
They took the labor of the peoples in possession,
45 that they might keep his statutes,
and observe his laws.
Praise Yah!

106

1 Praise Yahweh!
Give thanks to Yahweh, for he is good,
for his loving kindness endures forever.
2 Who can utter the mighty acts of Yahweh,
or fully declare all his praise?
3 Blessed are those who keep justice.
Blessed is one who does what is right at all times.
4 Remember me, Yahweh, with the favor that you show to your people.
Visit me with your salvation,
5 that I may see the prosperity of your chosen,
that I may rejoice in the gladness of your nation,
that I may glory with your inheritance.

6 We have sinned with our fathers.
We have committed iniquity.
We have done wickedly.
7 Our fathers didn't understand your wonders in Egypt.
They didn't remember the multitude of your loving kindnesses,
but were rebellious at the sea, even at the Red Sea.
8 Nevertheless he saved them for his name's sake,
that he might make his mighty power known.
9 He rebuked the Red Sea also, and it was dried up;
so he led them through the depths, as through a desert.
10 He saved them from the hand of him who hated them,
and redeemed them from the hand of the enemy.
11 The waters covered their adversaries.
There was not one of them left.
12 Then they believed his words.
They sang his praise.

13 They soon forgot his works.
They didn't wait for his counsel,
14 but gave in to craving in the desert,
and tested God in the wasteland.
15 He gave them their request,
but sent leanness into their soul.
16 They envied Moses also in the camp,
and Aaron, Yahweh's saint.
17 The earth opened and swallowed up Dathan,
and covered the company of Abiram.
18 A fire was kindled in their company.
The flame burned up the wicked.
19 They made a calf in Horeb,
and worshiped a molten image.
20 Thus they exchanged their glory
for an image of a bull that eats grass.
21 They forgot God, their Savior,
who had done great things in Egypt,
22 wondrous works in the land of Ham,
and awesome things by the Red Sea.
23 Therefore he said that he would destroy them,
had Moses, his chosen, not stood before him in the breach,
to turn away his wrath, so that he wouldn't destroy them.
24 Yes, they despised the pleasant land.
They didn't believe his word,
25 but murmured in their tents,
and didn't listen to Yahweh's voice.
26 Therefore he swore to them
that he would overthrow them in the wilderness,
27 that he would overthrow their offspring among the nations,
and scatter them in the lands.
28 They joined themselves also to Baal Peor,
and ate the sacrifices of the dead.
29 Thus they provoked him to anger with their deeds.
The plague broke in on them.
30 Then Phinehas stood up and executed judgment,
so the plague was stopped.
31 That was credited to him for righteousness,
for all generations to come.
32 They angered him also at the waters of Meribah,
so that Moses was troubled for their sakes;
33 because they were rebellious against his spirit,
he spoke rashly with his lips.
34 They didn't destroy the peoples,
as Yahweh commanded them,

35 but mixed themselves with the nations,
and learned their works.
36 They served their idols,
which became a snare to them.
37 Yes, they sacrificed their sons and their daughters to demons.
38 They shed innocent blood,
even the blood of their sons and of their daughters,
whom they sacrificed to the idols of Canaan.
The land was polluted with blood.
39 Thus they were defiled with their works,
and prostituted themselves in their deeds.
40 Therefore Yahweh burned with anger against his people.
He abhorred his inheritance.
41 He gave them into the hand of the nations.
Those who hated them ruled over them.
42 Their enemies also oppressed them.
They were brought into subjection under their hand.
43 He rescued them many times,
but they were rebellious in their counsel,
and were brought low in their iniquity.
44 Nevertheless he regarded their distress,
when he heard their cry.
45 He remembered for them his covenant,
and repented according to the multitude of his loving kindnesses.
46 He made them also to be pitied
by all those who carried them captive.

47 Save us, Yahweh, our God,
gather us from among the nations,
to give thanks to your holy name,
to triumph in your praise!

48 Blessed be Yahweh, the God of Israel,
from everlasting even to everlasting!
Let all the people say, "Amen."
Praise Yah!

BOOK 5

107

1 Give thanks to Yahweh,† for he is good,
for his loving kindness endures forever.
2 Let the redeemed by Yahweh say so,
whom he has redeemed from the hand of the adversary,
3 and gathered out of the lands,
from the east and from the west,
from the north and from the south.

4 They wandered in the wilderness in a desert way.
They found no city to live in.
5 Hungry and thirsty,
their soul fainted in them.
6 Then they cried to Yahweh in their trouble,
and he delivered them out of their distresses.
7 He led them also by a straight way,
that they might go to a city to live in.
8 Let them praise Yahweh for his loving kindness,
for his wonderful deeds to the children of men!

9 For he satisfies the longing soul.
He fills the hungry soul with good.

10 Some sat in darkness and in the shadow of death,
being bound in affliction and iron,
11 because they rebelled against the words of God,‡
and condemned the counsel of the Most High.
12 Therefore he brought down their heart with labor.
They fell down, and there was no one to help.
13 Then they cried to Yahweh in their trouble,
and he saved them out of their distresses.
14 He brought them out of darkness and the shadow of death,
and broke away their chains.
15 Let them praise Yahweh for his loving kindness,

† **107:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **107:11** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

for his wonderful deeds to the
children of men!

16 For he has broken the gates of bronze,
and cut through bars of iron.

17 Fools are afflicted because of their
disobedience,
and because of their iniquities.
18 Their soul abhors all kinds of food.
They draw near to the gates of death.
19 Then they cry to Yahweh in their
trouble,
and he saves them out of their
distresses.
20 He sends his word, and heals them,
and delivers them from their graves.
21 Let them praise Yahweh for his loving
kindness,
for his wonderful deeds to the
children of men!

22 Let them offer the sacrifices of
thanksgiving,
and declare his deeds with singing.

23 Those who go down to the sea in ships,
who do business in great waters,
24 these see Yahweh's deeds,
and his wonders in the deep.
25 For he commands, and raises the
stormy wind,
which lifts up its waves.
26 They mount up to the sky; they go down
again to the depths.
Their soul melts away because of
trouble.
27 They reel back and forth, and stagger
like a drunken man,
and are at their wits' end.
28 Then they cry to Yahweh in their
trouble,
and he brings them out of their
distress.
29 He makes the storm a calm,
so that its waves are still.
30 Then they are glad because it is calm,
so he brings them to their desired
haven.
31 Let them praise Yahweh for his loving
kindness,
for his wonderful deeds for the
children of men!
32 Let them exalt him also in the assembly
of the people,
and praise him in the seat of the
elders.

33 He turns rivers into a desert,
water springs into a thirsty ground,
34 and a fruitful land into a salt waste,
for the wickedness of those who dwell
in it.
35 He turns a desert into a pool of water,
and a dry land into water springs.
36 There he makes the hungry live,
that they may prepare a city to live in,
37 sow fields, plant vineyards,
and reap the fruits of increase.
38 He blesses them also, so that they are
multiplied greatly.
He doesn't allow their livestock to
decrease.
39 Again, they are diminished and bowed
down
through oppression, trouble, and
sorrow.
40 He pours contempt on princes,
and causes them to wander in a
trackless waste.
41 Yet he lifts the needy out of their
affliction,
and increases their families like a
flock.
42 The upright will see it, and be glad.
All the wicked will shut their mouths.
43 Whoever is wise will pay attention to
these things.
They will consider the loving
kindnesses of Yahweh.

108

A Song. A Psalm by David.
1 My heart is steadfast, God.
I will sing and I will make music with
my soul.
2 Wake up, harp and lyre!
I will wake up the dawn.
3 I will give thanks to you, Yahweh, among
the nations.
I will sing praises to you among the
peoples.
4 For your loving kindness is great above
the heavens.
Your faithfulness reaches to the skies.
5 Be exalted, God, above the heavens!
Let your glory be over all the earth.

6 That your beloved may be delivered,
save with your right hand, and
answer us.
7 God has spoken from his sanctuary: “In
triumph,
I will divide Shechem, and measure
out the valley of Succoth.
8 Gilead is mine. Manasseh is mine.
Ephraim also is my helmet.
Judah is my scepter.
9 Moab is my wash pot.
I will toss my sandal on Edom.
I will shout over Philistia.”
10 Who will bring me into the fortified
city?
Who will lead me to Edom?
11 Haven’t you rejected us, God?
You don’t go out, God, with our
armies.
12 Give us help against the enemy,
for the help of man is vain.
13 Through God, we will do valiantly,
for it is he who will tread down our
enemies.

109

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 God of my praise, don’t remain silent,
2 for they have opened the mouth of
the wicked and the mouth of deceit
against me.
They have spoken to me with a lying
tongue.
3 They have also surrounded me with
words of hatred,
and fought against me without a
cause.
4 In return for my love, they are my
adversaries;
but I am in prayer.
5 They have rewarded me evil for good,
and hatred for my love.
6 Set a wicked man over him.
Let an adversary stand at his right
hand.
7 When he is judged, let him come out
guilty.
Let his prayer be turned into sin.
8 Let his days be few.
Let another take his office.
9 Let his children be fatherless,
and his wife a widow.
10 Let his children be wandering beggars.
Let them be sought from their ruins.
11 Let the creditor seize all that he has.
Let strangers plunder the fruit of his
labor.
12 Let there be no one to extend kindness
to him,
neither let there be anyone to have
pity on his fatherless children.
13 Let his posterity be cut off.
In the generation following let their
name be blotted out.
14 Let the iniquity of his fathers be
remembered by Yahweh.
Don’t let the sin of his mother be
blotted out.
15 Let them be before Yahweh continually,
that he may cut off their memory
from the earth;
16 because he didn’t remember to show
kindness,
but persecuted the poor and needy
man,
the broken in heart, to kill them.
17 Yes, he loved cursing, and it came to
him.
He didn’t delight in blessing, and it
was far from him.
18 He clothed himself also with cursing as
with his garment.
It came into his inward parts like
water,
like oil into his bones.
19 Let it be to him as the clothing with
which he covers himself,
for the belt that is always around him.
20 This is the reward of my adversaries
from Yahweh,
of those who speak evil against my
soul.

21 But deal with me, Yahweh the Lord,† for
your name’s sake,
because your loving kindness is good,
deliver me;
22 for I am poor and needy.
My heart is wounded within me.
23 I fade away like an evening shadow.
I am shaken off like a locust.
24 My knees are weak through fasting.
My body is thin and lacks fat.
25 I have also become a reproach to them.

† **109:21** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai.”

When they see me, they shake their
head.
26 Help me, Yahweh, my God.
Save me according to your loving
kindness;
27 that they may know that this is your
hand;
that you, Yahweh, have done it.
28 They may curse, but you bless.
When they arise, they will be shamed,
but your servant shall rejoice.
29 Let my adversaries be clothed with
dishonor.
Let them cover themselves with their
own shame as with a robe.
30 I will give great thanks to Yahweh with
my mouth.
Yes, I will praise him among the
multitude.
31 For he will stand at the right hand of the
needy,
to save him from those who judge his
soul.

110

A Psalm by David.
1 Yahweh says to my Lord, “Sit at my right
hand,
until I make your enemies your
footstool for your feet.”
2 Yahweh will send out the rod of your
strength out of Zion.
Rule among your enemies.
3 Your people offer themselves willingly in
the day of your power, in holy
array.
Out of the womb of the morning, you
have the dew of your youth.
4 Yahweh has sworn, and will not change
his mind:
“You are a priest forever in the order
of Melchizedek.”
5 The Lord is at your right hand.
He will crush kings in the day of his
wrath.
6 He will judge among the nations.
He will heap up dead bodies.
He will crush the ruler of the whole
earth.
7 He will drink of the brook on the way;
therefore he will lift up his head.

111

1 Praise Yah!†
I will give thanks to Yahweh with my
whole heart,
in the council of the upright, and in
the congregation.
2 Yahweh’s works are great,
pondered by all those who delight in
them.
3 His work is honor and majesty.
His righteousness endures forever.
4 He has caused his wonderful works to be
remembered.
Yahweh is gracious and merciful.
5 He has given food to those who fear him.
He always remembers his covenant.
6 He has shown his people the power of
his works,
in giving them the heritage of the
nations.
7 The works of his hands are truth and
justice.
All his precepts are sure.
8 They are established forever and ever.
They are done in truth and
uprightness.
9 He has sent redemption to his people.
He has ordained his covenant forever.
His name is holy and awesome!
10 The fear of Yahweh is the beginning of
wisdom.
All those who do his work have a
good understanding.
His praise endures forever!

112

1 Praise Yah!†
Blessed is the man who fears Yahweh,
who delights greatly in his
commandments.
2 His offspring will be mighty in the land.
The generation of the upright will be
blessed.
3 Wealth and riches are in his house.
His righteousness endures forever.
4 Light dawns in the darkness for the
upright,
gracious, merciful, and righteous.

† **111:1** Psalm 111 is an acrostic poem, with each verse after the initial “Praise Yah!” starting with a letter of the alphabet (ordered from Alef to Tav). † **112:1** Psalm 112 is an acrostic poem, with each verse after the initial “Praise Yah!” starting with a letter of the alphabet (ordered from Alef to Tav).

5 It is well with the man who deals
graciously and lends.
He will maintain his cause in
judgment.
6 For he will never be shaken.
The righteous will be remembered
forever.
7 He will not be afraid of evil news.
His heart is steadfast, trusting in
Yahweh.
8 His heart is established.
He will not be afraid in the end when
he sees his adversaries.
9 He has dispersed, he has given to the
poor.
His righteousness endures forever.
His horn will be exalted with honor.
10 The wicked will see it, and be grieved.
He shall gnash with his teeth, and
melt away.
The desire of the wicked will perish.

113

1 Praise Yah!
Praise, you servants of Yahweh,
praise Yahweh's name.
2 Blessed be Yahweh's name,
from this time forward and forever
more.
3 From the rising of the sun to its going
down,
Yahweh's name is to be praised.
4 Yahweh is high above all nations,
his glory above the heavens.
5 Who is like Yahweh, our God,
who has his seat on high,
6 who stoops down to see in heaven
and in the earth?
7 He raises up the poor out of the dust,
and lifts up the needy from the ash
heap,
8 that he may set him with princes,
even with the princes of his people.
9 He settles the barren woman in her
home
as a joyful mother of children.
Praise Yah!

114

1 When Israel went out of Egypt,
the house of Jacob from a people of
foreign language,
2 Judah became his sanctuary,
Israel his dominion.
3 The sea saw it, and fled.
The Jordan was driven back.
4 The mountains skipped like rams,
the little hills like lambs.
5 What was it, you sea, that you fled?
You Jordan, that you turned back?
6 You mountains, that you skipped like
rams?
You little hills, like lambs?
7 Tremble, you earth, at the presence of
the Lord,
at the presence of the God of Jacob,
8 who turned the rock into a pool of water,
the flint into a spring of waters.

115

1 Not to us, Yahweh, not to us,
but to your name give glory,
for your loving kindness, and for your
truth's sake.
2 Why should the nations say,
"Where is their God, now?"
3 But our God is in the heavens.
He does whatever he pleases.
4 Their idols are silver and gold,
the work of men's hands.
5 They have mouths, but they don't speak.
They have eyes, but they don't see.
6 They have ears, but they don't hear.
They have noses, but they don't smell.
7 They have hands, but they don't feel.
They have feet, but they don't walk,
neither do they speak through their
throat.
8 Those who make them will be like them;
yes, everyone who trusts in them.
9 Israel, trust in Yahweh!
He is their help and their shield.
10 House of Aaron, trust in Yahweh!
He is their help and their shield.
11 You who fear Yahweh, trust in Yahweh!
He is their help and their shield.
12 Yahweh remembers us. He will bless us.
He will bless the house of Israel.
He will bless the house of Aaron.
13 He will bless those who fear Yahweh,
both small and great.
14 May Yahweh increase you more and
more,
you and your children.
15 Blessed are you by Yahweh,
who made heaven and earth.
16 The heavens are Yahweh's heavens,

but he has given the earth to the
children of men.
17 The dead don't praise Yah,
nor any who go down into silence,
18 but we will bless Yah,
from this time forward and forever
more.
Praise Yah!

116

1 I love Yahweh, because he listens to my
voice,
and my cries for mercy.
2 Because he has turned his ear to me,
therefore I will call on him as long as I
live.
3 The cords of death surrounded me,
the pains of Sheol† got a hold of me.
I found trouble and sorrow.
4 Then I called on Yahweh's name:
"Yahweh, I beg you, deliver my soul."
5 Yahweh is gracious and righteous.
Yes, our God is merciful.
6 Yahweh preserves the simple.
I was brought low, and he saved me.
7 Return to your rest, my soul,
for Yahweh has dealt bountifully with
you.
8 For you have delivered my soul from
death,
my eyes from tears,
and my feet from falling.
9 I will walk before Yahweh in the land of
the living.
10 I believed, therefore I said,
"I was greatly afflicted."
11 I said in my haste,
"All people are liars."
12 What will I give to Yahweh for all his
benefits toward me?
13 I will take the cup of salvation, and
call on Yahweh's name.
14 I will pay my vows to Yahweh,
yes, in the presence of all his people.
15 Precious in Yahweh's sight is the death
of his saints.
16 Yahweh, truly I am your servant.
I am your servant, the son of your
servant girl.
You have freed me from my chains.
17 I will offer to you the sacrifice of
thanksgiving,
and will call on Yahweh's name.
18 I will pay my vows to Yahweh,
yes, in the presence of all his people,
19 in the courts of Yahweh's house,
in the middle of you, Jerusalem.
Praise Yah!

† **116:3** Sheol is the place of the dead.

117

1 Praise Yahweh, all you nations!
Extol him, all you peoples!
2 For his loving kindness is great toward
us.
Yahweh's faithfulness endures
forever.
Praise Yah!

118

1 Give thanks to Yahweh, for he is good,
for his loving kindness endures
forever.
2 Let Israel now say
that his loving kindness endures
forever.
3 Let the house of Aaron now say
that his loving kindness endures
forever.
4 Now let those who fear Yahweh say
that his loving kindness endures
forever.
5 Out of my distress, I called on Yah.
Yah answered me with freedom.
6 Yahweh is on my side. I will not be
afraid.
What can man do to me?
7 Yahweh is on my side among those who
help me.
Therefore I will look in triumph at
those who hate me.
8 It is better to take refuge in Yahweh,
than to put confidence in man.
9 It is better to take refuge in Yahweh,
than to put confidence in princes.
10 All the nations surrounded me,
but in Yahweh's name I cut them off.
11 They surrounded me, yes, they
surrounded me.
In Yahweh's name I indeed cut them
off.
12 They surrounded me like bees.
They are quenched like the burning
thorns.
In Yahweh's name I cut them off.

13 You pushed me back hard, to make me fall,
but Yahweh helped me.
14 Yah is my strength and song.
He has become my salvation.
15 The voice of rejoicing and salvation is in the tents of the righteous.
"The right hand of Yahweh does valiantly.
16 The right hand of Yahweh is exalted!
The right hand of Yahweh does valiantly!"
17 I will not die, but live,
and declare Yah's works.
18 Yah has punished me severely,
but he has not given me over to death.
19 Open to me the gates of righteousness.
I will enter into them.
I will give thanks to Yah.
20 This is the gate of Yahweh;
the righteous will enter into it.
21 I will give thanks to you, for you have answered me,
and have become my salvation.
22 The stone which the builders rejected has become the cornerstone.†
23 This is Yahweh's doing.
It is marvelous in our eyes.
24 This is the day that Yahweh has made.
We will rejoice and be glad in it!
25 Save us now, we beg you, Yahweh!
Yahweh, we beg you, send prosperity now.
26 Blessed is he who comes in Yahweh's name!
We have blessed you out of Yahweh's house.
27 Yahweh is God, and he has given us light.
Bind the sacrifice with cords, even to the horns of the altar.
28 You are my God, and I will give thanks to you.
You are my God, I will exalt you.
29 Oh give thanks to Yahweh, for he is good,
for his loving kindness endures forever.

119

ALEPH

1 Blessed are those whose ways are blameless,
who walk according to Yahweh's law.
2 Blessed are those who keep his statutes,
who seek him with their whole heart.
3 Yes, they do nothing wrong.
They walk in his ways.
4 You have commanded your precepts,
that we should fully obey them.
5 Oh that my ways were steadfast to obey your statutes!
6 Then I wouldn't be disappointed,
when I consider all of your commandments.
7 I will give thanks to you with uprightness of heart,
when I learn your righteous judgments.
8 I will observe your statutes.
Don't utterly forsake me.
BETH
9 How can a young man keep his way pure?
By living according to your word.
10 With my whole heart I have sought you.
Don't let me wander from your commandments.
11 I have hidden your word in my heart,
that I might not sin against you.
12 Blessed are you, Yahweh.
Teach me your statutes.
13 With my lips,
I have declared all the ordinances of your mouth.
14 I have rejoiced in the way of your testimonies,
as much as in all riches.
15 I will meditate on your precepts,
and consider your ways.
16 I will delight myself in your statutes.
I will not forget your word.
GIMEL
17 Do good to your servant.
I will live and I will obey your word.
18 Open my eyes,
that I may see wondrous things out of your law.
19 I am a stranger on the earth.
Don't hide your commandments from me.

† **118:22** Literally, *head of the corner*

20 My soul is consumed with longing for
your ordinances at all times.
21 You have rebuked the proud who are
cursed,
who wander from your
commandments.
22 Take reproach and contempt away from
me,
for I have kept your statutes.
23 Though princes sit and slander me,
your servant will meditate on your
statutes.
24 Indeed your statutes are my delight,
and my counselors.
DALETH
25 My soul is laid low in the dust.
Revive me according to your word!
26 I declared my ways, and you answered
me.
Teach me your statutes.
27 Let me understand the teaching of your
precepts!
Then I will meditate on your
wondrous works.
28 My soul is weary with sorrow;
strengthen me according to your
word.
29 Keep me from the way of deceit.
Grant me your law graciously!
30 I have chosen the way of truth.
I have set your ordinances before me.
31 I cling to your statutes, Yahweh.
Don't let me be disappointed.
32 I run in the path of your
commandments,
for you have set my heart free.
HE
33 Teach me, Yahweh, the way of your
statutes.
I will keep them to the end.
34 Give me understanding, and I will keep
your law.
Yes, I will obey it with my whole heart.
35 Direct me in the path of your
commandments,
for I delight in them.
36 Turn my heart toward your statutes,
not toward selfish gain.
37 Turn my eyes away from looking at
worthless things.
Revive me in your ways.
38 Fulfill your promise to your servant,
that you may be feared.
39 Take away my disgrace that I dread,
for your ordinances are good.
40 Behold, I long for your precepts!
Revive me in your righteousness.
VAV
41 Let your loving kindness also come to
me, Yahweh,
your salvation, according to your
word.
42 So I will have an answer for him who
reproaches me,
for I trust in your word.
43 Don't snatch the word of truth out of my
mouth,
for I put my hope in your ordinances.
44 So I will obey your law continually,
forever and ever.
45 I will walk in liberty,
for I have sought your precepts.
46 I will also speak of your statutes before
kings,
and will not be disappointed.
47 I will delight myself in your
commandments,
because I love them.
48 I reach out my hands for your
commandments, which I love.
I will meditate on your statutes.
ZAYIN
49 Remember your word to your servant,
because you gave me hope.
50 This is my comfort in my affliction,
for your word has revived me.
51 The arrogant mock me excessively,
but I don't swerve from your law.
52 I remember your ordinances of old,
Yahweh,
and have comforted myself.
53 Indignation has taken hold on me,
because of the wicked who forsake
your law.
54 Your statutes have been my songs
in the house where I live.
55 I have remembered your name,
Yahweh, in the night,
and I obey your law.
56 This is my way,
that I keep your precepts.
HETH
57 Yahweh is my portion.
I promised to obey your words.

58 I sought your favor with my whole
heart.
Be merciful to me according to your
word.
59 I considered my ways,
and turned my steps to your statutes.
60 I will hurry, and not delay,
to obey your commandments.
61 The ropes of the wicked bind me,
but I won't forget your law.
62 At midnight I will rise to give thanks to
you,
because of your righteous
ordinances.
63 I am a friend of all those who fear you,
of those who observe your precepts.
64 The earth is full of your loving kindness,
Yahweh.
Teach me your statutes.
TETH
65 You have treated your servant well,
according to your word, Yahweh.
66 Teach me good judgment and
knowledge,
for I believe in your commandments.
67 Before I was afflicted, I went astray;
but now I observe your word.
68 You are good, and do good.
Teach me your statutes.
69 The proud have smeared a lie upon me.
With my whole heart, I will keep your
precepts.
70 Their heart is as callous as the fat,
but I delight in your law.
71 It is good for me that I have been
afflicted,
that I may learn your statutes.
72 The law of your mouth is better to me
than thousands of pieces of gold
and silver.
YODH
73 Your hands have made me and formed
me.
Give me understanding, that I may
learn your commandments.
74 Those who fear you will see me and be
glad,
because I have put my hope in your
word.
75 Yahweh, I know that your judgments
are righteous,
that in faithfulness you have afflicted
me.
76 Please let your loving kindness be for
my comfort,
according to your word to your
servant.
77 Let your tender mercies come to me,
that I may live;
for your law is my delight.
78 Let the proud be disappointed, for they
have overthrown me wrongfully.
I will meditate on your precepts.
79 Let those who fear you turn to me.
They will know your statutes.
80 Let my heart be blameless toward your
decrees,
that I may not be disappointed.
KAPF
81 My soul faints for your salvation.
I hope in your word.
82 My eyes fail for your word.
I say, "When will you comfort me?"
83 For I have become like a wineskin in the
smoke.
I don't forget your statutes.
84 How many are the days of your servant?
When will you execute judgment on
those who persecute me?
85 The proud have dug pits for me,
contrary to your law.
86 All of your commandments are faithful.
They persecute me wrongfully.
Help me!
87 They had almost wiped me from the
earth,
but I didn't forsake your precepts.
88 Preserve my life according to your
loving kindness,
so I will obey the statutes of your
mouth.
LAMEDH
89 Yahweh, your word is settled in heaven
forever.
90 Your faithfulness is to all generations.
You have established the earth, and it
remains.
91 Your laws remain to this day,
for all things serve you.
92 Unless your law had been my delight,
I would have perished in my
affliction.
93 I will never forget your precepts,

for with them, you have revived me.
94 I am yours.
Save me, for I have sought your precepts.
95 The wicked have waited for me, to destroy me.
I will consider your statutes.
96 I have seen a limit to all perfection,
but your commands are boundless.
MEM
97 How I love your law!
It is my meditation all day.
98 Your commandments make me wiser than my enemies,
for your commandments are always with me.
99 I have more understanding than all my teachers,
for your testimonies are my meditation.
100 I understand more than the aged,
because I have kept your precepts.
101 I have kept my feet from every evil way,
that I might observe your word.
102 I have not turned away from your ordinances,
for you have taught me.
103 How sweet are your promises to my taste,
more than honey to my mouth!
104 Through your precepts, I get understanding;
therefore I hate every false way.
NUN
105 Your word is a lamp to my feet,
and a light for my path.
106 I have sworn, and have confirmed it,
that I will obey your righteous ordinances.
107 I am afflicted very much.
Revive me, Yahweh, according to your word.
108 Accept, I beg you, the willing offerings of my mouth.
Yahweh, teach me your ordinances.
109 My soul is continually in my hand,
yet I won't forget your law.
110 The wicked have laid a snare for me,
yet I haven't gone astray from your precepts.
111 I have taken your testimonies as a heritage forever,
for they are the joy of my heart.
112 I have set my heart to perform your statutes forever,
even to the end.
SAMEKH
113 I hate double-minded men,
but I love your law.
114 You are my hiding place and my shield.
I hope in your word.
115 Depart from me, you evildoers,
that I may keep the commandments of my God.
116 Uphold me according to your word, that I may live.
Let me not be ashamed of my hope.
117 Hold me up, and I will be safe,
and will have respect for your statutes continually.
118 You reject all those who stray from your statutes,
for their deceit is in vain.
119 You put away all the wicked of the earth like dross.
Therefore I love your testimonies.
120 My flesh trembles for fear of you.
I am afraid of your judgments.
AYIN
121 I have done what is just and righteous.
Don't leave me to my oppressors.
122 Ensure your servant's well-being.
Don't let the proud oppress me.
123 My eyes fail looking for your salvation,
for your righteous word.
124 Deal with your servant according to your loving kindness.
Teach me your statutes.
125 I am your servant. Give me understanding,
that I may know your testimonies.
126 It is time to act, Yahweh,
for they break your law.
127 Therefore I love your commandments more than gold,
yes, more than pure gold.
128 Therefore I consider all of your precepts to be right.
I hate every false way.
PE
129 Your testimonies are wonderful,
therefore my soul keeps them.

130 The entrance of your words gives light.
It gives understanding to the simple.
131 I opened my mouth wide and panted,
for I longed for your commandments.
132 Turn to me, and have mercy on me,
as you always do to those who love your name.
133 Establish my footsteps in your word.
Don't let any iniquity have dominion over me.
134 Redeem me from the oppression of man,
so I will observe your precepts.
135 Make your face shine on your servant.
Teach me your statutes.
136 Streams of tears run down my eyes,
because they don't observe your law.
TZADHE
137 You are righteous, Yahweh.
Your judgments are upright.
138 You have commanded your statutes in righteousness.
They are fully trustworthy.
139 My zeal wears me out,
because my enemies ignore your words.
140 Your promises have been thoroughly tested,
and your servant loves them.
141 I am small and despised.
I don't forget your precepts.
142 Your righteousness is an everlasting righteousness.
Your law is truth.
143 Trouble and anguish have taken hold of me.
Your commandments are my delight.
144 Your testimonies are righteous forever.
Give me understanding, that I may live.
QOPH
145 I have called with my whole heart.
Answer me, Yahweh!
I will keep your statutes.
146 I have called to you. Save me!
I will obey your statutes.
147 I rise before dawn and cry for help.
I put my hope in your words.
148 My eyes stay open through the night watches,
that I might meditate on your word.
149 Hear my voice according to your loving kindness.
Revive me, Yahweh, according to your ordinances.
150 They draw near who follow after wickedness.
They are far from your law.
151 You are near, Yahweh.
All your commandments are truth.
152 Of old I have known from your testimonies,
that you have founded them forever.
RESH
153 Consider my affliction, and deliver me,
for I don't forget your law.
154 Plead my cause, and redeem me!
Revive me according to your promise.
155 Salvation is far from the wicked,
for they don't seek your statutes.
156 Great are your tender mercies, Yahweh.
Revive me according to your ordinances.
157 Many are my persecutors and my adversaries.
I haven't swerved from your testimonies.
158 I look at the faithless with loathing,
because they don't observe your word.
159 Consider how I love your precepts.
Revive me, Yahweh, according to your loving kindness.
160 All of your words are truth.
Every one of your righteous ordinances endures forever.
SIN AND SHIN
161 Princes have persecuted me without a cause,
but my heart stands in awe of your words.
162 I rejoice at your word,
as one who finds great plunder.
163 I hate and abhor falsehood.
I love your law.
164 Seven times a day, I praise you,
because of your righteous ordinances.
165 Those who love your law have great peace.
Nothing causes them to stumble.
166 I have hoped for your salvation, Yahweh.

I have done your commandments.
167 My soul has observed your testimonies.
I love them exceedingly.
168 I have obeyed your precepts and your testimonies,
for all my ways are before you.
TAV
169 Let my cry come before you, Yahweh.
Give me understanding according to your word.
170 Let my supplication come before you.
Deliver me according to your word.
171 Let my lips utter praise,
for you teach me your statutes.
172 Let my tongue sing of your word,
for all your commandments are righteousness.
173 Let your hand be ready to help me,
for I have chosen your precepts.
174 I have longed for your salvation, Yahweh.
Your law is my delight.
175 Let my soul live, that I may praise you.
Let your ordinances help me.
176 I have gone astray like a lost sheep.
Seek your servant, for I don't forget your commandments.

120

A Song of Ascents.
1 In my distress, I cried to Yahweh.
He answered me.
2 Deliver my soul, Yahweh, from lying lips,
from a deceitful tongue.
3 What will be given to you, and what will be done more to you,
you deceitful tongue?
4 Sharp arrows of the mighty,
with coals of juniper.
5 Woe is me, that I live in Meshech,
that I dwell among the tents of Kedar!
6 My soul has had her dwelling too long
with him who hates peace.
7 I am for peace,
but when I speak, they are for war.

121

A Song of Ascents.
1 I will lift up my eyes to the hills.
Where does my help come from?
2 My help comes from Yahweh,
who made heaven and earth.
3 He will not allow your foot to be moved.
He who keeps you will not slumber.
4 Behold, he who keeps Israel
will neither slumber nor sleep.
5 Yahweh is your keeper.
Yahweh is your shade on your right hand.
6 The sun will not harm you by day,
nor the moon by night.
7 Yahweh will keep you from all evil.
He will keep your soul.
8 Yahweh will keep your going out and your coming in,
from this time forward, and forever more.

122

A Song of Ascents. By David.
1 I was glad when they said to me,
"Let's go to Yahweh's house!"
2 Our feet are standing within your gates, Jerusalem!
3 Jerusalem is built as a city that is compact together,
4 where the tribes go up, even Yah's tribes,
according to an ordinance for Israel,
to give thanks to Yahweh's name.
5 For there are set thrones for judgment,
the thrones of David's house.
6 Pray for the peace of Jerusalem.
Those who love you will prosper.
7 Peace be within your walls,
and prosperity within your palaces.
8 For my brothers' and companions' sakes,
I will now say, "Peace be within you."
9 For the sake of the house of Yahweh our God,
I will seek your good.

123

A Song of Ascents.
1 I lift up my eyes to you,
you who sit in the heavens.
2 Behold, as the eyes of servants look to the hand of their master,
as the eyes of a maid to the hand of her mistress,
so our eyes look to Yahweh, our God,
until he has mercy on us.

3 Have mercy on us, Yahweh, have mercy on us,
for we have endured much contempt.
4 Our soul is exceedingly filled with the scoffing of those who are at ease,
with the contempt of the proud.

124

A Song of Ascents. By David.
1 If it had not been Yahweh who was on our side,
let Israel now say,
2 if it had not been Yahweh who was on our side,
when men rose up against us,
3 then they would have swallowed us up alive,
when their wrath was kindled against us,
4 then the waters would have overwhelmed us,
the stream would have gone over our soul.
5 Then the proud waters would have gone over our soul.
6 Blessed be Yahweh,
who has not given us as a prey to their teeth.
7 Our soul has escaped like a bird out of the fowler's snare.
The snare is broken, and we have escaped.
8 Our help is in Yahweh's name,
who made heaven and earth.

125

A Song of Ascents.
1 Those who trust in Yahweh are as Mount Zion,
which can't be moved, but remains forever.
2 As the mountains surround Jerusalem,
so Yahweh surrounds his people from this time forward and forever more.
3 For the scepter of wickedness won't remain over the allotment of the righteous,
so that the righteous won't use their hands to do evil.
4 Do good, Yahweh, to those who are good,
to those who are upright in their hearts.
5 But as for those who turn away to their crooked ways,
Yahweh will lead them away with the workers of iniquity.
Peace be on Israel.

126

A Song of Ascents.
1 When Yahweh brought back those who returned to Zion,
we were like those who dream.
2 Then our mouth was filled with laughter,
and our tongue with singing.
Then they said among the nations,
"Yahweh has done great things for them."
3 Yahweh has done great things for us,
and we are glad.
4 Restore our fortunes again, Yahweh,
like the streams in the Negev.
5 Those who sow in tears will reap in joy.
6 He who goes out weeping, carrying seed for sowing,
will certainly come again with joy,
carrying his sheaves.

127

A Song of Ascents. By Solomon.
1 Unless Yahweh builds the house,
they who build it labor in vain.
Unless Yahweh watches over the city,
the watchman guards it in vain.
2 It is vain for you to rise up early,
to stay up late,
eating the bread of toil,
for he gives sleep to his loved ones.
3 Behold, children are a heritage of Yahweh.
The fruit of the womb is his reward.
4 As arrows in the hand of a mighty man,
so are the children of youth.
5 Happy is the man who has his quiver full of them.
They won't be disappointed when they speak with their enemies in the gate.

128

A Song of Ascents.
1 Blessed is everyone who fears Yahweh,
who walks in his ways.
2 For you will eat the labor of your hands.

You will be happy, and it will be well
with you.
3 Your wife will be as a fruitful vine in the
innermost parts of your house,
your children like olive shoots
around your table.
4 Behold, this is how the man who fears
Yahweh is blessed.
5 May Yahweh bless you out of Zion,
and may you see the good of
Jerusalem all the days of your life.
6 Yes, may you see your children's
children.
Peace be upon Israel.

129

A Song of Ascents.
1 Many times they have afflicted me from
my youth up.
Let Israel now say:
2 many times they have afflicted me from
my youth up,
yet they have not prevailed against
me.
3 The plowers plowed on my back.
They made their furrows long.
4 Yahweh is righteous.
He has cut apart the cords of the
wicked.
5 Let them be disappointed and turned
backward,
all those who hate Zion.
6 Let them be as the grass on the
housetops,
which withers before it grows up,
7 with which the reaper doesn't fill his
hand,
nor he who binds sheaves, his bosom.
8 Neither do those who go by say,
"The blessing of Yahweh be on you.
We bless you in Yahweh's name."

130

A Song of Ascents.
1 Out of the depths I have cried to you,
Yahweh.
2 Lord, hear my voice.
Let your ears be attentive to the voice
of my petitions.
3 If you, Yah, kept a record of sins,
Lord, who could stand?
4 But there is forgiveness with you,
therefore you are feared.
5 I wait for Yahweh.
My soul waits.
I hope in his word.
6 My soul longs for the Lord more than
watchmen long for the morning,
more than watchmen for the
morning.
7 Israel, hope in Yahweh,
for there is loving kindness with
Yahweh.
Abundant redemption is with him.
8 He will redeem Israel from all their sins.

131

A Song of Ascents. By David.
1 Yahweh, my heart isn't arrogant, nor my
eyes lofty;
nor do I concern myself with great
matters,
or things too wonderful for me.
2 Surely I have stilled and quieted my soul,
like a weaned child with his mother,
like a weaned child is my soul within
me.
3 Israel, hope in Yahweh,
from this time forward and forever
more.

132

A Song of Ascents.
1 Yahweh, remember David and all his
affliction,
2 how he swore to Yahweh,
and vowed to the Mighty One of
Jacob:
3 "Surely I will not come into the structure
of my house,
nor go up into my bed;
4 I will not give sleep to my eyes,
or slumber to my eyelids,
5 until I find out a place for Yahweh,
a dwelling for the Mighty One of
Jacob."
6 Behold, we heard of it in Ephrathah.
We found it in the field of Jaar.
7 "We will go into his dwelling place.
We will worship at his footstool."
8 Arise, Yahweh, into your resting place,
you, and the ark of your strength.
9 Let your priests be clothed with
righteousness.

Let your saints shout for joy!
10 For your servant David's sake,
don't turn away the face of your
anointed one.
11 Yahweh has sworn to David in truth.
He will not turn from it:
"I will set the fruit of your body on
your throne.
12 If your children will keep my covenant,
my testimony that I will teach them,
their children also will sit on your
throne forever more."
13 For Yahweh has chosen Zion.
He has desired it for his habitation.
14 "This is my resting place forever.
I will live here, for I have desired it.
15 I will abundantly bless her provision.
I will satisfy her poor with bread.
16 I will also clothe her priests with
salvation.
Her saints will shout aloud for joy.
17 I will make the horn of David to bud
there.
I have ordained a lamp for my
anointed.
18 I will clothe his enemies with shame,
but on himself, his crown will shine."

133

A Song of Ascents. By David.
1 See how good and how pleasant it is
for brothers to live together in unity!
2 It is like the precious oil on the head,
that ran down on the beard,
even Aaron's beard,
that came down on the edge of his
robes,
3 like the dew of Hermon,
that comes down on the hills of Zion;
for there Yahweh gives the blessing,
even life forever more.

134

A Song of Ascents.
1 Look! Praise Yahweh, all you servants of
Yahweh,
who stand by night in Yahweh's
house!
2 Lift up your hands in the sanctuary.
Praise Yahweh!
3 May Yahweh bless you from Zion,
even he who made heaven and earth.

135

1 Praise Yah!
Praise Yahweh's name!
Praise him, you servants of Yahweh,
2 you who stand in Yahweh's house,
in the courts of our God's house.
3 Praise Yah, for Yahweh is good.
Sing praises to his name, for that is
pleasant.
4 For Yah has chosen Jacob for himself,
Israel for his own possession.
5 For I know that Yahweh is great,
that our Lord is above all gods.
6 Whatever Yahweh pleased, that he has
done,
in heaven and in earth, in the seas
and in all deeps.
7 He causes the clouds to rise from the
ends of the earth.
He makes lightnings with the rain.
He brings the wind out of his
treasuries.
8 He struck the firstborn of Egypt,
both of man and animal.
9 He sent signs and wonders into the
middle of you, Egypt,
on Pharaoh, and on all his servants.
10 He struck many nations,
and killed mighty kings—
11 Sihon king of the Amorites,
Og king of Bashan,
and all the kingdoms of Canaan—
12 and gave their land for a heritage,
a heritage to Israel, his people.
13 Your name, Yahweh, endures forever;
your renown, Yahweh, throughout all
generations.
14 For Yahweh will judge his people
and have compassion on his servants.

15 The idols of the nations are silver and
gold,
the work of men's hands.
16 They have mouths, but they can't speak.
They have eyes, but they can't see.
17 They have ears, but they can't hear,
neither is there any breath in their
mouths.
18 Those who make them will be like them,
yes, everyone who trusts in them.
19 House of Israel, praise Yahweh!
House of Aaron, praise Yahweh!

20 House of Levi, praise Yahweh!
You who fear Yahweh, praise Yahweh!
21 Blessed be Yahweh from Zion,
who dwells in Jerusalem.
Praise Yah!

136

1 Give thanks to Yahweh, for he is good,
for his loving kindness endures
forever.
2 Give thanks to the God of gods,
for his loving kindness endures
forever.
3 Give thanks to the Lord of lords,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
4 to him who alone does great wonders,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
5 to him who by understanding made the
heavens,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
6 to him who spread out the earth above
the waters,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
7 to him who made the great lights,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
8 the sun to rule by day,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
9 the moon and stars to rule by night,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
10 to him who struck down the Egyptian
firstborn,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
11 and brought out Israel from among
them,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
12 with a strong hand, and with an
outstretched arm,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
13 to him who divided the Red Sea apart,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
14 and made Israel to pass through the
middle of it,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
15 but overthrew Pharaoh and his army in
the Red Sea,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
16 to him who led his people through the
wilderness,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
17 to him who struck great kings,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
18 and killed mighty kings,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
19 Sihon king of the Amorites,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
20 Og king of Bashan,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
21 and gave their land as an inheritance,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
22 even a heritage to Israel his servant,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
23 who remembered us in our low estate,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
24 and has delivered us from our
adversaries,
for his loving kindness endures
forever;
25 who gives food to every creature,
for his loving kindness endures
forever.
26 Oh give thanks to the God of heaven,
for his loving kindness endures
forever.

137

1 By the rivers of Babylon, there we sat
down.
Yes, we wept, when we remembered
Zion.
2 On the willows in that land,
we hung up our harps.

3 For there, those who led us captive asked
us for songs.
Those who tormented us demanded
songs of joy:
"Sing us one of the songs of Zion!"
4 How can we sing Yahweh's song in a
foreign land?
5 If I forget you, Jerusalem,
let my right hand forget its skill.
6 Let my tongue stick to the roof of my
mouth if I don't remember you,
if I don't prefer Jerusalem above my
chief joy.
7 Remember, Yahweh, against the children
of Edom in the day of Jerusalem,
who said, "Raze it!
Raze it even to its foundation!"
8 Daughter of Babylon, doomed to
destruction,
he will be happy who repays you,
as you have done to us.
9 Happy shall he be,
who takes and dashes your little ones
against the rock.

138

By David.
1 I will give you thanks with my whole
heart.
Before the gods,† I will sing praises to
you.
2 I will bow down toward your holy
temple,
and give thanks to your Name for
your loving kindness and for your
truth;
for you have exalted your Name and
your Word above all.
3 In the day that I called, you answered
me.
You encouraged me with strength in
my soul.
4 All the kings of the earth will give you
thanks, Yahweh,
for they have heard the words of your
mouth.
5 Yes, they will sing of the ways of Yahweh,
for Yahweh's glory is great!
6 For though Yahweh is high, yet he looks
after the lowly;
but he knows the proud from afar.
7 Though I walk in the middle of trouble,
you will revive me.
You will stretch out your hand against
the wrath of my enemies.
Your right hand will save me.
8 Yahweh will fulfill that which concerns
me.
Your loving kindness, Yahweh,
endures forever.
Don't forsake the works of your own
hands.

139

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 Yahweh, you have searched me,
and you know me.
2 You know my sitting down and my rising
up.
You perceive my thoughts from afar.
3 You search out my path and my lying
down,
and are acquainted with all my ways.
4 For there is not a word on my tongue,
but behold, Yahweh, you know it
altogether.
5 You hem me in behind and before.
You laid your hand on me.
6 This knowledge is beyond me.
It's lofty.
I can't attain it.
7 Where could I go from your Spirit?
Or where could I flee from your
presence?
8 If I ascend up into heaven, you are there.
If I make my bed in Sheol,† behold,
you are there!
9 If I take the wings of the dawn,
and settle in the uttermost parts of
the sea,
10 even there your hand will lead me,
and your right hand will hold me.
11 If I say, "Surely the darkness will
overwhelm me.
The light around me will be night,"
12 even the darkness doesn't hide from
you,
but the night shines as the day.
The darkness is like light to you.
13 For you formed my inmost being.

† **138:1** The word elohim, used here, usually means "God" but can also mean "gods", "princes", or "angels". † **139:8** Sheol is the place of the dead.

You knit me together in my mother's
womb.
14 I will give thanks to you,
for I am fearfully and wonderfully
made.
Your works are wonderful.
My soul knows that very well.
15 My frame wasn't hidden from you,
when I was made in secret,
woven together in the depths of the
earth.
16 Your eyes saw my body.
In your book they were all written,
the days that were ordained for me,
when as yet there were none of them.
17 How precious to me are your thoughts,
God!
How vast is their sum!
18 If I would count them, they are more in
number than the sand.
When I wake up, I am still with you.
19 If only you, God, would kill the wicked.
Get away from me, you bloodthirsty
men!
20 For they speak against you wickedly.
Your enemies take your name in vain.
21 Yahweh, don't I hate those who hate
you?
Am I not grieved with those who rise
up against you?
22 I hate them with perfect hatred.
They have become my enemies.
23 Search me, God, and know my heart.
Try me, and know my thoughts.
24 See if there is any wicked way in me,
and lead me in the everlasting way.

140

For the Chief Musician. A Psalm by David.
1 Deliver me, Yahweh, from evil men.
Preserve me from violent men:
2 those who devise mischief in their
hearts.
They continually gather themselves
together for war.
3 They have sharpened their tongues like
a serpent.
Viper's poison is under their lips.
Selah.
4 Yahweh, keep me from the hands of the
wicked.
Preserve me from the violent men
who have determined to trip my
feet.
5 The proud have hidden a snare for me,
they have spread the cords of a net by
the path.
They have set traps for me.
Selah.
6 I said to Yahweh, "You are my God."
Listen to the cry of my petitions,
Yahweh.
7 Yahweh, the Lord, the strength of my
salvation,
you have covered my head in the day
of battle.
8 Yahweh, don't grant the desires of the
wicked.
Don't let their evil plans succeed, or
they will become proud.
Selah.
9 As for the head of those who surround
me,
let the mischief of their own lips
cover them.
10 Let burning coals fall on them.
Let them be thrown into the fire,
into miry pits, from where they never
rise.
11 An evil speaker won't be established in
the earth.
Evil will hunt the violent man to
overthrow him.
12 I know that Yahweh will maintain the
cause of the afflicted,
and justice for the needy.
13 Surely the righteous will give thanks to
your name.
The upright will dwell in your
presence.

141

A Psalm by David.
1 Yahweh, I have called on you.
Come to me quickly!
Listen to my voice when I call to you.
2 Let my prayer be set before you like
incense;
the lifting up of my hands like the
evening sacrifice.
3 Set a watch, Yahweh, before my mouth.
Keep the door of my lips.
4 Don't incline my heart to any evil thing,
to practice deeds of wickedness with
men who work iniquity.

Don't let me eat of their delicacies.
5 Let the righteous strike me, it is
kindness;
let him reprove me, it is like oil on the
head;
don't let my head refuse it;
Yet my prayer is always against evil
deeds.
6 Their judges are thrown down by the
sides of the rock.
They will hear my words, for they are
well spoken.
7 "As when one plows and breaks up the
earth,
our bones are scattered at the mouth
of Sheol."†
8 For my eyes are on you, Yahweh, the
Lord.
I take refuge in you.
Don't leave my soul destitute.
9 Keep me from the snare which they have
laid for me,
from the traps of the workers of
iniquity.
10 Let the wicked fall together into their
own nets
while I pass by.

142

A contemplation by David, when he was in the cave. A Prayer.
1 I cry with my voice to Yahweh.
With my voice, I ask Yahweh for
mercy.
2 I pour out my complaint before him.
I tell him my troubles.
3 When my spirit was overwhelmed
within me,
you knew my route.
On the path in which I walk,
they have hidden a snare for me.
4 Look on my right, and see;
for there is no one who is concerned
for me.
Refuge has fled from me.
No one cares for my soul.
5 I cried to you, Yahweh.
I said, "You are my refuge,
my portion in the land of the living."
6 Listen to my cry,
for I am in desperate need.
Deliver me from my persecutors,
for they are too strong for me.
7 Bring my soul out of prison,
that I may give thanks to your name.
The righteous will surround me,
for you will be good to me.

143

A Psalm by David.
1 Hear my prayer, Yahweh.
Listen to my petitions.
In your faithfulness and
righteousness, relieve me.
2 Don't enter into judgment with your
servant,
for in your sight no man living is
righteous.
3 For the enemy pursues my soul.
He has struck my life down to the
ground.
He has made me live in dark places,
as those who have been long dead.
4 Therefore my spirit is overwhelmed
within me.
My heart within me is desolate.
5 I remember the days of old.
I meditate on all your doings.
I contemplate the work of your hands.
6 I spread out my hands to you.
My soul thirsts for you, like a parched
land.
Selah.
7 Hurry to answer me, Yahweh.
My spirit fails.
Don't hide your face from me,
so that I don't become like those who
go down into the pit.
8 Cause me to hear your loving kindness in
the morning,
for I trust in you.
Cause me to know the way in which I
should walk,
for I lift up my soul to you.
9 Deliver me, Yahweh, from my enemies.
I flee to you to hide me.
10 Teach me to do your will,
for you are my God.
Your Spirit is good.
Lead me in the land of uprightness.

† **141:7** Sheol is the place of the dead.

11 Revive me, Yahweh, for your name's
sake.
In your righteousness, bring my soul
out of trouble.
12 In your loving kindness, cut off my
enemies,
and destroy all those who afflict my
soul,
for I am your servant.

144

By David.
1 Blessed be Yahweh, my rock,
who trains my hands to war,
and my fingers to battle—
2 my loving kindness, my fortress,
my high tower, my deliverer,
my shield, and he in whom I take
refuge,
who subdues my people under me.
3 Yahweh, what is man, that you care for
him?
Or the son of man, that you think of
him?
4 Man is like a breath.
His days are like a shadow that passes
away.
5 Part your heavens, Yahweh, and come
down.
Touch the mountains, and they will
smoke.
6 Throw out lightning, and scatter them.
Send out your arrows, and rout them.
7 Stretch out your hand from above,
rescue me, and deliver me out of
great waters,
out of the hands of foreigners,
8 whose mouths speak deceit,
whose right hand is a right hand of
falsehood.
9 I will sing a new song to you, God.
On a ten-stringed lyre, I will sing
praises to you.
10 You are he who gives salvation to kings,
who rescues David, his servant, from
the deadly sword.
11 Rescue me, and deliver me out of the
hands of foreigners,
whose mouths speak deceit,
whose right hand is a right hand of
falsehood.

12 Then our sons will be like well-nurtured
plants,
our daughters like pillars carved to
adorn a palace.
13 Our barns are full, filled with all kinds
of provision.
Our sheep produce thousands and
ten thousands in our fields.
14 Our oxen will pull heavy loads.
There is no breaking in, and no going
away,
and no outcry in our streets.
15 Happy are the people who are in such a
situation.
Happy are the people whose God is
Yahweh.

145

A praise psalm by David.†
1 I will exalt you, my God, the King.
I will praise your name forever and
ever.
2 Every day I will praise you.
I will extol your name forever and
ever.
3 Great is Yahweh, and greatly to be
praised!
His greatness is unsearchable.
4 One generation will commend your
works to another,
and will declare your mighty acts.
5 I will meditate on the glorious majesty of
your honor,
on your wondrous works.
6 Men will speak of the might of your
awesome acts.
I will declare your greatness.
7 They will utter the memory of your great
goodness,
and will sing of your righteousness.
8 Yahweh is gracious, merciful,
slow to anger, and of great loving
kindness.
9 Yahweh is good to all.
His tender mercies are over all his
works.
10 All your works will give thanks to you,
Yahweh.

† **145:** This is an acrostic psalm, with every verse (including the second half of verse 13) starting with a consecutive letter of the Hebrew alphabet.

Your saints will extol you.
11 They will speak of the glory of your
kingdom,
and talk about your power,
12 to make known to the sons of men his
mighty acts,
the glory of the majesty of his
kingdom.
13 Your kingdom is an everlasting
kingdom.
Your dominion endures throughout
all generations.
Yahweh is faithful in all his words,
and loving in all his deeds.‡
14 Yahweh upholds all who fall,
and raises up all those who are
bowed down.
15 The eyes of all wait for you.
You give them their food in due
season.
16 You open your hand,
and satisfy the desire of every living
thing.
17 Yahweh is righteous in all his ways,
and gracious in all his works.
18 Yahweh is near to all those who call on
him,
to all who call on him in truth.
19 He will fulfill the desire of those who
fear him.
He also will hear their cry, and will
save them.
20 Yahweh preserves all those who love
him,
but he will destroy all the wicked.
21 My mouth will speak the praise of
Yahweh.
Let all flesh bless his holy name
forever and ever.

146

1 Praise Yah!
Praise Yahweh, my soul.
2 While I live, I will praise Yahweh.
I will sing praises to my God as long as
I exist.
3 Don't put your trust in princes,
in a son of man in whom there is no
help.
4 His spirit departs, and he returns to the
earth.
In that very day, his thoughts perish.
5 Happy is he who has the God of Jacob for
his help,
whose hope is in Yahweh, his God,
6 who made heaven and earth,
the sea, and all that is in them;
who keeps truth forever;
7 who executes justice for the oppressed;
who gives food to the hungry.
Yahweh frees the prisoners.
8 Yahweh opens the eyes of the blind.
Yahweh raises up those who are
bowed down.
Yahweh loves the righteous.
9 Yahweh preserves the foreigners.
He upholds the fatherless and widow,
but he turns the way of the wicked
upside down.
10 Yahweh will reign forever;
your God, O Zion, to all generations.
Praise Yah!

147

1 Praise Yah,
for it is good to sing praises to our
God;
for it is pleasant and fitting to praise
him.
2 Yahweh builds up Jerusalem.
He gathers together the outcasts of
Israel.
3 He heals the broken in heart,
and binds up their wounds.
4 He counts the number of the stars.
He calls them all by their names.
5 Great is our Lord, and mighty in power.
His understanding is infinite.
6 Yahweh upholds the humble.
He brings the wicked down to the
ground.
7 Sing to Yahweh with thanksgiving.
Sing praises on the harp to our God,
8 who covers the sky with clouds,
who prepares rain for the earth,
who makes grass grow on the
mountains.
9 He provides food for the livestock,
and for the young ravens when they
call.

‡ **145:13** Some manuscripts omit these last two lines.

10 He doesn't delight in the strength of the horse.
He takes no pleasure in the legs of a man.
11 Yahweh takes pleasure in those who fear him,
in those who hope in his loving kindness.
12 Praise Yahweh, Jerusalem!
Praise your God, Zion!
13 For he has strengthened the bars of your gates.
He has blessed your children within you.
14 He makes peace in your borders.
He fills you with the finest of the wheat.
15 He sends out his commandment to the earth.
His word runs very swiftly.
16 He gives snow like wool,
and scatters frost like ashes.
17 He hurls down his hail like pebbles.
Who can stand before his cold?
18 He sends out his word, and melts them.
He causes his wind to blow, and the waters flow.
19 He shows his word to Jacob,
his statutes and his ordinances to Israel.
20 He has not done this for just any nation.
They don't know his ordinances.
Praise Yah!

148

1 Praise Yah!
Praise Yahweh from the heavens!
Praise him in the heights!
2 Praise him, all his angels!
Praise him, all his army!
3 Praise him, sun and moon!
Praise him, all you shining stars!
4 Praise him, you heavens of heavens,
you waters that are above the heavens.
5 Let them praise Yahweh's name,
for he commanded, and they were created.
6 He has also established them forever and ever.
He has made a decree which will not pass away.
7 Praise Yahweh from the earth,
you great sea creatures, and all depths,
8 lightning and hail, snow and clouds,
stormy wind, fulfilling his word,
9 mountains and all hills,
fruit trees and all cedars,
10 wild animals and all livestock,
small creatures and flying birds,
11 kings of the earth and all peoples,
princes and all judges of the earth,
12 both young men and maidens,
old men and children.
13 Let them praise Yahweh's name,
for his name alone is exalted.
His glory is above the earth and the heavens.
14 He has lifted up the horn of his people,
the praise of all his saints,
even of the children of Israel, a people near to him.
Praise Yah!

149

1 Praise Yahweh!
Sing to Yahweh a new song,
his praise in the assembly of the saints.
2 Let Israel rejoice in him who made them.
Let the children of Zion be joyful in their King.
3 Let them praise his name in the dance!
Let them sing praises to him with tambourine and harp!
4 For Yahweh takes pleasure in his people.
He crowns the humble with salvation.
5 Let the saints rejoice in honor.
Let them sing for joy on their beds.
6 May the high praises of God be in their mouths,
and a two-edged sword in their hand,
7 to execute vengeance on the nations,
and punishments on the peoples;
8 to bind their kings with chains,
and their nobles with fetters of iron;
9 to execute on them the written judgment.
All his saints have this honor.
Praise Yah!

150

1 Praise Yah!

Praise God in his sanctuary!
Praise him in his heavens for his acts of power!
2 Praise him for his mighty acts!
Praise him according to his excellent greatness!
3 Praise him with the sounding of the trumpet!
Praise him with harp and lyre!
4 Praise him with tambourine and dancing!
Praise him with stringed instruments and flute!
5 Praise him with loud cymbals!
Praise him with resounding cymbals!
6 Let everything that has breath praise Yah!
Praise Yah!

The Proverbs

1 The proverbs of Solomon, the son of
David, king of Israel:
2 to know wisdom and instruction;
to discern the words of
understanding;
3 to receive instruction in wise dealing,
in righteousness, justice, and equity;
4 to give prudence to the simple,
knowledge and discretion to the
young man—
5 that the wise man may hear, and
increase in learning;
that the man of understanding may
attain to sound counsel;
6 to understand a proverb and parables,
the words and riddles of the wise.

7 The fear of Yahweh† is the beginning of
knowledge,
but the foolish despise wisdom and
instruction.
8 My son, listen to your father's
instruction,
and don't forsake your mother's
teaching;
9 for they will be a garland to grace your
head,
and chains around your neck.
10 My son, if sinners entice you,
don't consent.
11 If they say, "Come with us.
Let's lie in wait for blood.
Let's lurk secretly for the innocent
without cause.
12 Let's swallow them up alive like Sheol,‡
and whole, like those who go down
into the pit.
13 We'll find all valuable wealth.
We'll fill our houses with plunder.
14 You shall cast your lot among us.
We'll all have one purse"—
15 my son, don't walk on the path with
them.
Keep your foot from their path,
16 for their feet run to evil.
They hurry to shed blood.
17 For the net is spread in vain in the sight
of any bird;
18 but these lay in wait for their own
blood.
They lurk secretly for their own lives.
19 So are the ways of everyone who is
greedy for gain.
It takes away the life of its owners.

20 Wisdom calls aloud in the street.
She utters her voice in the public
squares.
21 She calls at the head of noisy places.
At the entrance of the city gates, she
utters her words:
22 "How long, you simple ones, will you
love simplicity?
How long will mockers delight
themselves in mockery,
and fools hate knowledge?
23 Turn at my reproof.
Behold,§ I will pour out my spirit on
you.
I will make known my words to you.
24 Because I have called, and you have
refused;
I have stretched out my hand, and no
one has paid attention;
25 but you have ignored all my counsel,
and wanted none of my reproof;
26 I also will laugh at your disaster.
I will mock when calamity overtakes
you,
27 when calamity overtakes you like a
storm,
when your disaster comes on like a
whirlwind,
when distress and anguish come on
you.
28 Then they will call on me, but I will not
answer.
They will seek me diligently, but they
will not find me,
29 because they hated knowledge,
and didn't choose the fear of Yahweh.
30 They wanted none of my counsel.
They despised all my reproof.
31 Therefore they will eat of the fruit of
their own way,

† **1:7** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:12** Sheol is the place of the dead. § **1:23** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

and be filled with their own schemes.
32 For the backsliding of the simple will kill them.
The careless ease of fools will destroy them.
33 But whoever listens to me will dwell securely,
and will be at ease, without fear of harm.”

2

1 My son, if you will receive my words,
and store up my commandments within you,
2 so as to turn your ear to wisdom,
and apply your heart to understanding;
3 yes, if you call out for discernment,
and lift up your voice for understanding;
4 if you seek her as silver,
and search for her as for hidden treasures;
5 then you will understand the fear of Yahweh,
and find the knowledge of God.†
6 For Yahweh gives wisdom.
Out of his mouth comes knowledge and understanding.
7 He lays up sound wisdom for the upright.
He is a shield to those who walk in integrity,
8 that he may guard the paths of justice,
and preserve the way of his saints.
9 Then you will understand righteousness and justice,
equity and every good path.
10 For wisdom will enter into your heart.
Knowledge will be pleasant to your soul.
11 Discretion will watch over you.
Understanding will keep you,
12 to deliver you from the way of evil,
from the men who speak perverse things,
13 who forsake the paths of uprightness,
to walk in the ways of darkness,
14 who rejoice to do evil,
and delight in the perverseness of evil,
15 who are crooked in their ways,
and wayward in their paths,
16 to deliver you from the strange woman,
even from the foreigner who flatters with her words,
17 who forsakes the friend of her youth,
and forgets the covenant of her God;
18 for her house leads down to death,
her paths to the departed spirits.
19 None who go to her return again,
neither do they attain to the paths of life.
20 Therefore walk in the way of good men,
and keep the paths of the righteous.
21 For the upright will dwell in the land.
The perfect will remain in it.
22 But the wicked will be cut off from the land.
The treacherous will be rooted out of it.

3

1 My son, don’t forget my teaching,
but let your heart keep my commandments,
2 for they will add to you length of days,
years of life, and peace.
3 Don’t let kindness and truth forsake you.
Bind them around your neck.
Write them on the tablet of your heart.
4 So you will find favor,
and good understanding in the sight of God and man.
5 Trust in Yahweh with all your heart,
and don’t lean on your own understanding.
6 In all your ways acknowledge him,
and he will make your paths straight.
7 Don’t be wise in your own eyes.
Fear Yahweh, and depart from evil.
8 It will be health to your body,
and nourishment to your bones.
9 Honor Yahweh with your substance,
with the first fruits of all your increase;
10 so your barns will be filled with plenty,
and your vats will overflow with new wine.
11 My son, don’t despise Yahweh’s discipline,
neither be weary of his correction;

† **2:5** The Hebrew word rendered “God” is “אֱלֹהִים” (Elohim).

12 for whom Yahweh loves, he corrects,
even as a father reproves the son in whom he delights.

13 Happy is the man who finds wisdom,
the man who gets understanding.
14 For her good profit is better than getting silver,
and her return is better than fine gold.
15 She is more precious than rubies.
None of the things you can desire are to be compared to her.
16 Length of days is in her right hand.
In her left hand are riches and honor.
17 Her ways are ways of pleasantness.
All her paths are peace.
18 She is a tree of life to those who lay hold of her.
Happy is everyone who retains her.
19 By wisdom Yahweh founded the earth.
By understanding, he established the heavens.
20 By his knowledge, the depths were broken up,
and the skies drop down the dew.
21 My son, let them not depart from your eyes.
Keep sound wisdom and discretion,
22 so they will be life to your soul,
and grace for your neck.
23 Then you shall walk in your way securely.
Your foot won't stumble.
24 When you lie down, you will not be afraid.
Yes, you will lie down, and your sleep will be sweet.
25 Don't be afraid of sudden fear,
neither of the desolation of the wicked, when it comes;
26 for Yahweh will be your confidence,
and will keep your foot from being taken.

27 Don't withhold good from those to whom it is due,
when it is in the power of your hand to do it.
28 Don't say to your neighbor, "Go, and come again;
tomorrow I will give it to you,"
when you have it by you.
29 Don't devise evil against your neighbor,
since he dwells securely by you.
30 Don't strive with a man without cause,
if he has done you no harm.
31 Don't envy the man of violence.
Choose none of his ways.
32 For the perverse is an abomination to Yahweh,
but his friendship is with the upright.
33 Yahweh's curse is in the house of the wicked,
but he blesses the habitation of the righteous.
34 Surely he mocks the mockers,
but he gives grace to the humble.
35 The wise will inherit glory,
but shame will be the promotion of fools.

4

1 Listen, sons, to a father's instruction.
Pay attention and know understanding;
2 for I give you sound learning.
Don't forsake my law.
3 For I was a son to my father,
tender and an only child in the sight of my mother.
4 He taught me, and said to me:
"Let your heart retain my words.
Keep my commandments, and live.
5 Get wisdom.
Get understanding.
Don't forget, and don't deviate from the words of my mouth.
6 Don't forsake her, and she will preserve you.
Love her, and she will keep you.
7 Wisdom is supreme.
Get wisdom.
Yes, though it costs all your possessions, get understanding.
8 Esteem her, and she will exalt you.
She will bring you to honor when you embrace her.
9 She will give to your head a garland of grace.
She will deliver a crown of splendor to you."

10 Listen, my son, and receive my sayings.
The years of your life will be many.

11 I have taught you in the way of wisdom.
I have led you in straight paths.
12 When you go, your steps will not be hampered.
When you run, you will not stumble.
13 Take firm hold of instruction.
Don't let her go.
Keep her, for she is your life.
14 Don't enter into the path of the wicked.
Don't walk in the way of evil men.
15 Avoid it, and don't pass by it.
Turn from it, and pass on.
16 For they don't sleep unless they do evil.
Their sleep is taken away, unless they make someone fall.
17 For they eat the bread of wickedness and drink the wine of violence.
18 But the path of the righteous is like the dawning light
that shines more and more until the perfect day.
19 The way of the wicked is like darkness.
They don't know what they stumble over.

20 My son, attend to my words.
Turn your ear to my sayings.
21 Let them not depart from your eyes.
Keep them in the center of your heart.
22 For they are life to those who find them, and health to their whole body.
23 Keep your heart with all diligence, for out of it is the wellspring of life.
24 Put away from yourself a perverse mouth.
Put corrupt lips far from you.
25 Let your eyes look straight ahead.
Fix your gaze directly before you.
26 Make the path of your feet level.
Let all of your ways be established.
27 Don't turn to the right hand nor to the left.
Remove your foot from evil.

5

1 My son, pay attention to my wisdom.
Turn your ear to my understanding,
2 that you may maintain discretion,
that your lips may preserve knowledge.
3 For the lips of an adulteress drip honey.
Her mouth is smoother than oil,
4 but in the end she is as bitter as wormwood,
and as sharp as a two-edged sword.
5 Her feet go down to death.
Her steps lead straight to Sheol.†
6 She gives no thought to the way of life.
Her ways are crooked, and she doesn't know it.

7 Now therefore, my sons, listen to me.
Don't depart from the words of my mouth.
8 Remove your way far from her.
Don't come near the door of her house,
9 lest you give your honor to others,
and your years to the cruel one;
10 lest strangers feast on your wealth,
and your labors enrich another man's house.
11 You will groan at your latter end,
when your flesh and your body are consumed,
12 and say, "How I have hated instruction,
and my heart despised reproof.
13 I haven't obeyed the voice of my teachers,
nor turned my ear to those who instructed me!
14 I have come to the brink of utter ruin,
among the gathered assembly."

15 Drink water out of your own cistern,
running water out of your own well.
16 Should your springs overflow in the streets,
streams of water in the public squares?
17 Let them be for yourself alone,
not for strangers with you.
18 Let your spring be blessed.
Rejoice in the wife of your youth.
19 A loving doe and a graceful deer—
let her breasts satisfy you at all times.
Be captivated always with her love.
20 For why should you, my son, be captivated with an adulteress?
Why embrace the bosom of another?
21 For the ways of man are before Yahweh's eyes.

† **5:5** Sheol is the place of the dead.

He examines all his paths.
22 The evil deeds of the wicked ensnare him.
The cords of his sin hold him firmly.
23 He will die for lack of instruction.
In the greatness of his folly, he will go astray.

6

1 My son, if you have become collateral for your neighbor,
if you have struck your hands in pledge for a stranger,
2 you are trapped by the words of your mouth;
you are ensnared with the words of your mouth.
3 Do this now, my son, and deliver yourself,
since you have come into the hand of your neighbor.
Go, humble yourself.
Press your plea with your neighbor.
4 Give no sleep to your eyes,
nor slumber to your eyelids.
5 Free yourself, like a gazelle from the hand of the hunter,
like a bird from the snare of the fowler.

6 Go to the ant, you sluggard.
Consider her ways, and be wise;
7 which having no chief, overseer, or ruler,
8 provides her bread in the summer,
and gathers her food in the harvest.
9 How long will you sleep, sluggard?
When will you arise out of your sleep?
10 A little sleep, a little slumber,
a little folding of the hands to sleep—
11 so your poverty will come as a robber,
and your scarcity as an armed man.

12 A worthless person, a man of iniquity,
is he who walks with a perverse mouth,
13 who winks with his eyes, who signals with his feet,
who motions with his fingers,
14 in whose heart is perverseness,
who devises evil continually,
who always sows discord.
15 Therefore his calamity will come suddenly.
He will be broken suddenly, and that without remedy.

16 There are six things which Yahweh hates;
yes, seven which are an abomination to him:
17 arrogant eyes, a lying tongue,
hands that shed innocent blood,
18 a heart that devises wicked schemes,
feet that are swift in running to mischief,
19 a false witness who utters lies,
and he who sows discord among brothers.

20 My son, keep your father's commandment,
and don't forsake your mother's teaching.
21 Bind them continually on your heart.
Tie them around your neck.
22 When you walk, it will lead you.
When you sleep, it will watch over you.
When you awake, it will talk with you.
23 For the commandment is a lamp,
and the law is light.
Reproofs of instruction are the way of life,
24 to keep you from the immoral woman,
from the flattery of the wayward wife's tongue.
25 Don't lust after her beauty in your heart,
neither let her captivate you with her eyelids.
26 For a prostitute reduces you to a piece of bread.
The adulteress hunts for your precious life.
27 Can a man scoop fire into his lap,
and his clothes not be burned?
28 Or can one walk on hot coals,
and his feet not be scorched?
29 So is he who goes in to his neighbor's wife.
Whoever touches her will not be unpunished.
30 Men don't despise a thief

if he steals to satisfy himself when he
is hungry,
31 but if he is found, he shall restore seven
times.
He shall give all the wealth of his
house.
32 He who commits adultery with a
woman is void of understanding.
He who does it destroys his own soul.
33 He will get wounds and dishonor.
His reproach will not be wiped away.
34 For jealousy arouses the fury of the
husband.
He won't spare in the day of
vengeance.
35 He won't regard any ransom,
neither will he rest content, though
you give many gifts.

7

1 My son, keep my words.
Lay up my commandments within
you.
2 Keep my commandments and live!
Guard my teaching as the apple of
your eye.
3 Bind them on your fingers.
Write them on the tablet of your
heart.
4 Tell wisdom, "You are my sister."
Call understanding your relative,
5 that they may keep you from the strange
woman,
from the foreigner who flatters with
her words.
6 For at the window of my house,
I looked out through my lattice.
7 I saw among the simple ones.
I discerned among the youths a young
man void of understanding,
8 passing through the street near her
corner,
he went the way to her house,
9 in the twilight, in the evening of the day,
in the middle of the night and in the
darkness.
10 Behold, there a woman met him with
the attire of a prostitute,
and with crafty intent.
11 She is loud and defiant.
Her feet don't stay in her house.
12 Now she is in the streets, now in the
squares,
and lurking at every corner.
13 So she caught him, and kissed him.
With an impudent face she said to
him:
14 "Sacrifices of peace offerings are with
me.
Today I have paid my vows.
15 Therefore I came out to meet you,
to diligently seek your face,
and I have found you.
16 I have spread my couch with carpets of
tapestry,
with striped cloths of the yarn of
Egypt.
17 I have perfumed my bed with myrrh,
aloes, and cinnamon.
18 Come, let's take our fill of loving until
the morning.
Let's solace ourselves with loving.
19 For my husband isn't at home.
He has gone on a long journey.
20 He has taken a bag of money with him.
He will come home at the full moon."
21 With persuasive words, she led him
astray.
With the flattering of her lips, she
seduced him.
22 He followed her immediately,
as an ox goes to the slaughter,
as a fool stepping into a noose.
23 Until an arrow strikes through his liver,
as a bird hurries to the snare,
and doesn't know that it will cost his
life.

24 Now therefore, sons, listen to me.
Pay attention to the words of my
mouth.
25 Don't let your heart turn to her ways.
Don't go astray in her paths,
26 for she has thrown down many
wounded.
Yes, all her slain are a mighty army.
27 Her house is the way to Sheol,†
going down to the rooms of death.

8

1 Doesn't wisdom cry out?
Doesn't understanding raise her
voice?

† **7:27** Sheol is the place of the dead.

2 On the top of high places by the way,
where the paths meet, she stands.
3 Beside the gates, at the entry of the city,
at the entry doors, she cries aloud:
4 “I call to you men!
I send my voice to the sons of
mankind.
5 You simple, understand prudence!
You fools, be of an understanding
heart!
6 Hear, for I will speak excellent things.
The opening of my lips is for right
things.
7 For my mouth speaks truth.
Wickedness is an abomination to my
lips.
8 All the words of my mouth are in
righteousness.
There is nothing crooked or perverse
in them.
9 They are all plain to him who
understands,
right to those who find knowledge.
10 Receive my instruction rather than
silver,
knowledge rather than choice gold.
11 For wisdom is better than rubies.
All the things that may be desired
can’t be compared to it.

12 “I, wisdom, have made prudence my
dwelling.
Find out knowledge and discretion.
13 The fear of Yahweh is to hate evil.
I hate pride, arrogance, the evil way,
and the perverse mouth.
14 Counsel and sound knowledge are
mine.
I have understanding and power.
15 By me kings reign,
and princes decree justice.
16 By me princes rule,
nobles, and all the righteous rulers of
the earth.
17 I love those who love me.
Those who seek me diligently will
find me.
18 With me are riches, honor,
enduring wealth, and prosperity.
19 My fruit is better than gold, yes, than
fine gold,
my yield than choice silver.
20 I walk in the way of righteousness,
in the middle of the paths of justice,
21 that I may give wealth to those who love
me.
I fill their treasuries.

22 “Yahweh possessed me in the beginning
of his work,
before his deeds of old.
23 I was set up from everlasting, from the
beginning,
before the earth existed.
24 When there were no depths, I was born,
when there were no springs
abounding with water.
25 Before the mountains were settled in
place,
before the hills, I was born;
26 while as yet he had not made the earth,
nor the fields,
nor the beginning of the dust of the
world.
27 When he established the heavens, I was
there.
When he set a circle on the surface of
the deep,
28 when he established the clouds above,
when the springs of the deep became
strong,
29 when he gave to the sea its boundary,
that the waters should not violate his
commandment,
when he marked out the foundations
of the earth,
30 then I was the craftsman by his side.
I was a delight day by day,
always rejoicing before him,
31 rejoicing in his whole world.
My delight was with the sons of men.

32 “Now therefore, my sons, listen to me,
for blessed are those who keep my
ways.
33 Hear instruction, and be wise.
Don’t refuse it.
34 Blessed is the man who hears me,
watching daily at my gates,
waiting at my door posts.
35 For whoever finds me finds life,
and will obtain favor from Yahweh.
36 But he who sins against me wrongs his
own soul.
All those who hate me love death.”

9

1 Wisdom has built her house.
She has carved out her seven pillars.
2 She has prepared her meat.
She has mixed her wine.
She has also set her table.
3 She has sent out her maidens.
She cries from the highest places of the city:
4 “Whoever is simple, let him turn in here!”
As for him who is void of understanding, she says to him,
5 “Come, eat some of my bread,
Drink some of the wine which I have mixed!
6 Leave your simple ways, and live.
Walk in the way of understanding.”

7 One who corrects a mocker invites insult.
One who reproves a wicked man invites abuse.
8 Don’t reprove a scoffer, lest he hate you.
Reprove a wise person, and he will love you.
9 Instruct a wise person, and he will be still wiser.
Teach a righteous person, and he will increase in learning.
10 The fear of Yahweh is the beginning of wisdom.
The knowledge of the Holy One is understanding.
11 For by me your days will be multiplied.
The years of your life will be increased.
12 If you are wise, you are wise for yourself.
If you mock, you alone will bear it.

13 The foolish woman is loud,
undisciplined, and knows nothing.
14 She sits at the door of her house,
on a seat in the high places of the city,
15 to call to those who pass by,
who go straight on their ways,
16 “Whoever is simple, let him turn in here.”
As for him who is void of understanding, she says to him,
17 “Stolen water is sweet.
Food eaten in secret is pleasant.”
18 But he doesn’t know that the departed spirits are there,
that her guests are in the depths of Sheol.†

10

1 The proverbs of Solomon.
A wise son makes a glad father;
but a foolish son brings grief to his mother.
2 Treasures of wickedness profit nothing,
but righteousness delivers from death.
3 Yahweh will not allow the soul of the righteous to go hungry,
but he thrusts away the desire of the wicked.
4 He becomes poor who works with a lazy hand,
but the hand of the diligent brings wealth.
5 He who gathers in summer is a wise son,
but he who sleeps during the harvest is a son who causes shame.
6 Blessings are on the head of the righteous,
but violence covers the mouth of the wicked.
7 The memory of the righteous is blessed,
but the name of the wicked will rot.
8 The wise in heart accept commandments,
but a chattering fool will fall.
9 He who walks blamelessly walks surely,
but he who perverts his ways will be found out.
10 One who winks with the eye causes sorrow,
but a chattering fool will fall.
11 The mouth of the righteous is a spring of life,
but violence covers the mouth of the wicked.
12 Hatred stirs up strife,
but love covers all wrongs.
13 Wisdom is found on the lips of him who has discernment,
but a rod is for the back of him who is void of understanding.
14 Wise men lay up knowledge,

† **9:18** Sheol is the place of the dead.

but the mouth of the foolish is near ruin.
15 The rich man's wealth is his strong city.
The destruction of the poor is their poverty.
16 The labor of the righteous leads to life.
The increase of the wicked leads to sin.
17 He is in the way of life who heeds correction,
but he who forsakes reproof leads others astray.
18 He who hides hatred has lying lips.
He who utters a slander is a fool.
19 In the multitude of words there is no lack of disobedience,
but he who restrains his lips does wisely.
20 The tongue of the righteous is like choice silver.
The heart of the wicked is of little worth.
21 The lips of the righteous feed many,
but the foolish die for lack of understanding.
22 Yahweh's blessing brings wealth,
and he adds no trouble to it.
23 It is a fool's pleasure to do wickedness,
but wisdom is a man of understanding's pleasure.
24 What the wicked fear will overtake them,
but the desire of the righteous will be granted.
25 When the whirlwind passes, the wicked is no more;
but the righteous stand firm forever.
26 As vinegar to the teeth, and as smoke to the eyes,
so is the sluggard to those who send him.
27 The fear of Yahweh prolongs days,
but the years of the wicked shall be shortened.
28 The prospect of the righteous is joy,
but the hope of the wicked will perish.
29 The way of Yahweh is a stronghold to the upright,
but it is a destruction to the workers of iniquity.
30 The righteous will never be removed,
but the wicked will not dwell in the land.
31 The mouth of the righteous produces wisdom,
but the perverse tongue will be cut off.
32 The lips of the righteous know what is acceptable,
but the mouth of the wicked is perverse.

11

1 A false balance is an abomination to Yahweh,
but accurate weights are his delight.
2 When pride comes, then comes shame,
but with humility comes wisdom.
3 The integrity of the upright shall guide them,
but the perverseness of the treacherous shall destroy them.
4 Riches don't profit in the day of wrath,
but righteousness delivers from death.
5 The righteousness of the blameless will direct his way,
but the wicked shall fall by his own wickedness.
6 The righteousness of the upright shall deliver them,
but the unfaithful will be trapped by evil desires.
7 When a wicked man dies, hope perishes,
and expectation of power comes to nothing.
8 A righteous person is delivered out of trouble,
and the wicked takes his place.
9 With his mouth the godless man destroys his neighbor,
but the righteous will be delivered through knowledge.
10 When it goes well with the righteous, the city rejoices.
When the wicked perish, there is shouting.
11 By the blessing of the upright, the city is exalted,
but it is overthrown by the mouth of the wicked.
12 One who despises his neighbor is void of wisdom,
but a man of understanding holds his peace.

13 One who brings gossip betrays a
confidence,
but one who is of a trustworthy spirit
is one who keeps a secret.
14 Where there is no wise guidance, the
nation falls,
but in the multitude of counselors
there is victory.
15 He who is collateral for a stranger will
suffer for it,
but he who refuses pledges of
collateral is secure.
16 A gracious woman obtains honor,
but violent men obtain riches.
17 The merciful man does good to his own
soul,
but he who is cruel troubles his own
flesh.
18 Wicked people earn deceitful wages,
but one who sows righteousness
reaps a sure reward.
19 He who is truly righteous gets life.
He who pursues evil gets death.
20 Those who are perverse in heart are an
abomination to Yahweh,
but those whose ways are blameless
are his delight.
21 Most certainly, the evil man will not be
unpunished,
but the offspring† of the righteous will
be delivered.
22 Like a gold ring in a pig's snout,
is a beautiful woman who lacks
discretion.
23 The desire of the righteous is only good.
The expectation of the wicked is
wrath.
24 There is one who scatters, and increases
yet more.
There is one who withholds more
than is appropriate, but gains
poverty.
25 The liberal soul shall be made fat.
He who waters shall be watered also
himself.
26 People curse someone who withholds
grain,
but blessing will be on the head of
him who sells it.
27 He who diligently seeks good seeks
favor,
but he who searches after evil, it shall
come to him.
28 He who trusts in his riches will fall,
but the righteous shall flourish as the
green leaf.
29 He who troubles his own house shall
inherit the wind.
The foolish shall be servant to the
wise of heart.
30 The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life.
He who is wise wins souls.
31 Behold, the righteous shall be repaid in
the earth,
how much more the wicked and the
sinner!

12

1 Whoever loves correction loves
knowledge,
but he who hates reproof is stupid.
2 A good man shall obtain favor from
Yahweh,
but he will condemn a man of wicked
plans.
3 A man shall not be established by
wickedness,
but the root of the righteous shall not
be moved.
4 A worthy woman is the crown of her
husband,
but a disgraceful wife is as rottenness
in his bones.
5 The thoughts of the righteous are just,
but the advice of the wicked is
deceitful.
6 The words of the wicked are about lying
in wait for blood,
but the speech of the upright rescues
them.
7 The wicked are overthrown, and are no
more,
but the house of the righteous shall
stand.
8 A man shall be commended according to
his wisdom,
but he who has a warped mind shall
be despised.
9 Better is he who is little known, and has
a servant,
than he who honors himself and lacks
bread.
10 A righteous man respects the life of his
animal,

† **11:21** or, seed

but the tender mercies of the wicked
are cruel.
11 He who tills his land shall have plenty
of bread,
but he who chases fantasies is void of
understanding.
12 The wicked desires the plunder of evil
men,
but the root of the righteous
flourishes.
13 An evil man is trapped by sinfulness of
lips,
but the righteous shall come out of
trouble.
14 A man shall be satisfied with good by
the fruit of his mouth.
The work of a man's hands shall be
rewarded to him.
15 The way of a fool is right in his own
eyes,
but he who is wise listens to counsel.
16 A fool shows his annoyance the same
day,
but one who overlooks an insult is
prudent.
17 He who is truthful testifies honestly,
but a false witness lies.
18 There is one who speaks rashly like the
piercing of a sword,
but the tongue of the wise heals.
19 Truth's lips will be established forever,
but a lying tongue is only momentary.
20 Deceit is in the heart of those who plot
evil,
but joy comes to the promoters of
peace.
21 No mischief shall happen to the
righteous,
but the wicked shall be filled with
evil.
22 Lying lips are an abomination to
Yahweh,
but those who do the truth are his
delight.
23 A prudent man keeps his knowledge,
but the hearts of fools proclaim
foolishness.
24 The hands of the diligent ones shall rule,
but laziness ends in slave labor.
25 Anxiety in a man's heart weighs it
down,
but a kind word makes it glad.
26 A righteous person is cautious in
friendship,
but the way of the wicked leads them
astray.
27 The slothful man doesn't roast his game,
but the possessions of diligent men
are prized.
28 In the way of righteousness is life;
in its path there is no death.

13

1 A wise son listens to his father's
instruction,
but a scoffer doesn't listen to rebuke.
2 By the fruit of his lips, a man enjoys good
things,
but the unfaithful crave violence.
3 He who guards his mouth guards his
soul.
One who opens wide his lips comes to
ruin.
4 The soul of the sluggard desires, and has
nothing,
but the desire of the diligent shall be
fully satisfied.
5 A righteous man hates lies,
but a wicked man brings shame and
disgrace.
6 Righteousness guards the way of
integrity,
but wickedness overthrows the
sinner.
7 There are some who pretend to be rich,
yet have nothing.
There are some who pretend to be
poor, yet have great wealth.
8 The ransom of a man's life is his riches,
but the poor hear no threats.
9 The light of the righteous shines brightly,
but the lamp of the wicked is snuffed
out.
10 Pride only breeds quarrels,
but wisdom is with people who take
advice.
11 Wealth gained dishonestly dwindles
away,
but he who gathers by hand makes it
grow.
12 Hope deferred makes the heart sick,
but when longing is fulfilled, it is a
tree of life.
13 Whoever despises instruction will pay
for it,
but he who respects a command will
be rewarded.

14 The teaching of the wise is a spring of life,
to turn from the snares of death.
15 Good understanding wins favor,
but the way of the unfaithful is hard.
16 Every prudent man acts from knowledge,
but a fool exposes folly.
17 A wicked messenger falls into trouble,
but a trustworthy envoy gains healing.
18 Poverty and shame come to him who refuses discipline,
but he who heeds correction shall be honored.
19 Longing fulfilled is sweet to the soul,
but fools detest turning from evil.
20 One who walks with wise men grows wise,
but a companion of fools suffers harm.
21 Misfortune pursues sinners,
but prosperity rewards the righteous.
22 A good man leaves an inheritance to his children's children,
but the wealth of the sinner is stored for the righteous.
23 An abundance of food is in poor people's fields,
but injustice sweeps it away.
24 One who spares the rod hates his son,
but one who loves him is careful to discipline him.
25 The righteous one eats to the satisfying of his soul,
but the belly of the wicked goes hungry.

14

1 Every wise woman builds her house,
but the foolish one tears it down with her own hands.
2 He who walks in his uprightness fears Yahweh,
but he who is perverse in his ways despises him.
3 The fool's talk brings a rod to his back,
but the lips of the wise protect them.
4 Where no oxen are, the crib is clean,
but much increase is by the strength of the ox.
5 A truthful witness will not lie,
but a false witness pours out lies.
6 A scoffer seeks wisdom, and doesn't find it,
but knowledge comes easily to a discerning person.
7 Stay away from a foolish man,
for you won't find knowledge on his lips.
8 The wisdom of the prudent is to think about his way,
but the folly of fools is deceit.
9 Fools mock at making atonement for sins,
but among the upright there is good will.
10 The heart knows its own bitterness and joy;
he will not share these with a stranger.
11 The house of the wicked will be overthrown,
but the tent of the upright will flourish.
12 There is a way which seems right to a man,
but in the end it leads to death.
13 Even in laughter the heart may be sorrowful,
and mirth may end in heaviness.
14 The unfaithful will be repaid for his own ways;
likewise a good man will be rewarded for his ways.
15 A simple man believes everything,
but the prudent man carefully considers his ways.
16 A wise man fears and shuns evil,
but the fool is hot headed and reckless.
17 He who is quick to become angry will commit folly,
and a crafty man is hated.
18 The simple inherit folly,
but the prudent are crowned with knowledge.
19 The evil bow down before the good,
and the wicked at the gates of the righteous.
20 The poor person is shunned even by his own neighbor,
but the rich person has many friends.
21 He who despises his neighbor sins,

but he who has pity on the poor is
blessed.
22 Don't they go astray who plot evil?
But love and faithfulness belong to
those who plan good.
23 In all hard work there is profit,
but the talk of the lips leads only to
poverty.
24 The crown of the wise is their riches,
but the folly of fools crowns them
with folly.
25 A truthful witness saves souls,
but a false witness is deceitful.
26 In the fear of Yahweh is a secure
fortress,
and he will be a refuge for his
children.
27 The fear of Yahweh is a fountain of life,
turning people from the snares of
death.
28 In the multitude of people is the king's
glory,
but in the lack of people is the
destruction of the prince.
29 He who is slow to anger has great
understanding,
but he who has a quick temper
displays folly.
30 The life of the body is a heart at peace,
but envy rots the bones.
31 He who oppresses the poor shows
contempt for his Maker,
but he who is kind to the needy
honors him.
32 The wicked is brought down in his
calamity,
but in death, the righteous has a
refuge.
33 Wisdom rests in the heart of one who
has understanding,
and is even made known in the
inward part of fools.
34 Righteousness exalts a nation,
but sin is a disgrace to any people.
35 The king's favor is toward a servant
who deals wisely,
but his wrath is toward one who
causes shame.

15

1 A gentle answer turns away wrath,
but a harsh word stirs up anger.
2 The tongue of the wise commends
knowledge,
but the mouths of fools gush out folly.
3 Yahweh's eyes are everywhere,
keeping watch on the evil and the
good.
4 A gentle tongue is a tree of life,
but deceit in it crushes the spirit.
5 A fool despises his father's correction,
but he who heeds reproof shows
prudence.
6 In the house of the righteous is much
treasure,
but the income of the wicked brings
trouble.
7 The lips of the wise spread knowledge;
not so with the heart of fools.
8 The sacrifice made by the wicked is an
abomination to Yahweh,
but the prayer of the upright is his
delight.
9 The way of the wicked is an abomination
to Yahweh,
but he loves him who follows after
righteousness.
10 There is stern discipline for one who
forsakes the way.
Whoever hates reproof shall die.
11 Sheol† and Abaddon are before
Yahweh—
how much more then the hearts of
the children of men!
12 A scoffer doesn't love to be reproved;
he will not go to the wise.
13 A glad heart makes a cheerful face,
but an aching heart breaks the spirit.
14 The heart of one who has
understanding seeks knowledge,
but the mouths of fools feed on folly.
15 All the days of the afflicted are
wretched,
but one who has a cheerful heart
enjoys a continual feast.
16 Better is little, with the fear of Yahweh,
than great treasure with trouble.
17 Better is a dinner of herbs, where love
is,
than a fattened calf with hatred.
18 A wrathful man stirs up contention,

† **15:11** Sheol is the place of the dead.

but one who is slow to anger appeases
strife.
19 The way of the sluggard is like a thorn
patch,
but the path of the upright is a
highway.
20 A wise son makes a father glad,
but a foolish man despises his mother.
21 Folly is joy to one who is void of wisdom,
but a man of understanding keeps his
way straight.
22 Where there is no counsel, plans fail;
but in a multitude of counselors they
are established.
23 Joy comes to a man with the reply of his
mouth.
How good is a word at the right time!
24 The path of life leads upward for the
wise,
to keep him from going downward to
Sheol.‡
25 Yahweh will uproot the house of the
proud,
but he will keep the widow's borders
intact.
26 Yahweh detests the thoughts of the
wicked,
but the thoughts of the pure are
pleasing.
27 He who is greedy for gain troubles his
own house,
but he who hates bribes will live.
28 The heart of the righteous weighs
answers,
but the mouth of the wicked gushes
out evil.
29 Yahweh is far from the wicked,
but he hears the prayer of the
righteous.
30 The light of the eyes rejoices the heart.
Good news gives health to the bones.
31 The ear that listens to reproof lives,
and will be at home among the wise.
32 He who refuses correction despises his
own soul,
but he who listens to reproof gets
understanding.
33 The fear of Yahweh teaches wisdom.
Before honor is humility.

‡ **15:24** Sheol is the place of the dead.

16

1 The plans of the heart belong to man,
but the answer of the tongue is from
Yahweh.
2 All the ways of a man are clean in his
own eyes,
but Yahweh weighs the motives.
3 Commit your deeds to Yahweh,
and your plans shall succeed.
4 Yahweh has made everything for its own
end—
yes, even the wicked for the day of
evil.
5 Everyone who is proud in heart is an
abomination to Yahweh;
they shall certainly not be
unpunished.
6 By mercy and truth iniquity is atoned
for.
By the fear of Yahweh men depart
from evil.
7 When a man's ways please Yahweh,
he makes even his enemies to be at
peace with him.
8 Better is a little with righteousness,
than great revenues with injustice.
9 A man's heart plans his course,
but Yahweh directs his steps.
10 Inspired judgments are on the lips of
the king.
He shall not betray his mouth.
11 Honest balances and scales are
Yahweh's;
all the weights in the bag are his
work.
12 It is an abomination for kings to do
wrong,
for the throne is established by
righteousness.
13 Righteous lips are the delight of kings.
They value one who speaks the truth.
14 The king's wrath is a messenger of
death,
but a wise man will pacify it.
15 In the light of the king's face is life.
His favor is like a cloud of the spring
rain.
16 How much better it is to get wisdom
than gold!
Yes, to get understanding is to be
chosen rather than silver.

17 The highway of the upright is to depart
from evil.
He who keeps his way preserves his
soul.
18 Pride goes before destruction,
and an arrogant spirit before a fall.
19 It is better to be of a lowly spirit with the
poor,
than to divide the plunder with the
proud.
20 He who heeds the Word finds
prosperity.
Whoever trusts in Yahweh is blessed.
21 The wise in heart shall be called
prudent.
Pleasantness of the lips promotes
instruction.
22 Understanding is a fountain of life to
one who has it,
but the punishment of fools is their
folly.
23 The heart of the wise instructs his
mouth,
and adds learning to his lips.
24 Pleasant words are a honeycomb,
sweet to the soul, and health to the
bones.
25 There is a way which seems right to a
man,
but in the end it leads to death.
26 The appetite of the laboring man labors
for him,
for his mouth urges him on.
27 A worthless man devises mischief.
His speech is like a scorching fire.
28 A perverse man stirs up strife.
A whisperer separates close friends.
29 A man of violence entices his neighbor,
and leads him in a way that is not
good.
30 One who winks his eyes to plot
perversities,
one who compresses his lips, is bent
on evil.
31 Gray hair is a crown of glory.
It is attained by a life of righteousness.
32 One who is slow to anger is better than
the mighty;
one who rules his spirit, than he who
takes a city.
33 The lot is cast into the lap,
but its every decision is from Yahweh.

17

1 Better is a dry morsel with quietness,
than a house full of feasting with
strife.
2 A servant who deals wisely will rule over
a son who causes shame,
and shall have a part in the
inheritance among the brothers.
3 The refining pot is for silver, and the
furnace for gold,
but Yahweh tests the hearts.
4 An evildoer heeds wicked lips.
A liar gives ear to a mischievous
tongue.
5 Whoever mocks the poor reproaches his
Maker.
He who is glad at calamity shall not
be unpunished.
6 Children's children are the crown of old
men;
the glory of children is their parents.
7 Excellent speech isn't fitting for a fool,
much less do lying lips fit a prince.
8 A bribe is a precious stone in the eyes of
him who gives it;
wherever he turns, he prospers.
9 He who covers an offense promotes love;
but he who repeats a matter
separates best friends.
10 A rebuke enters deeper into one who
has understanding
than a hundred lashes into a fool.
11 An evil man seeks only rebellion;
therefore a cruel messenger shall be
sent against him.
12 Let a bear robbed of her cubs meet a
man,
rather than a fool in his folly.
13 Whoever rewards evil for good,
evil shall not depart from his house.
14 The beginning of strife is like breaching
a dam,
therefore stop contention before
quarreling breaks out.
15 He who justifies the wicked, and he who
condemns the righteous,
both of them alike are an
abomination to Yahweh.
16 Why is there money in the hand of a
fool to buy wisdom,
since he has no understanding?
17 A friend loves at all times;

and a brother is born for adversity.
18 A man void of understanding strikes
hands,
and becomes collateral in the
presence of his neighbor.
19 He who loves disobedience loves strife.
One who builds a high gate seeks
destruction.
20 One who has a perverse heart doesn't
find prosperity,
and one who has a deceitful tongue
falls into trouble.
21 He who becomes the father of a fool
grieves.
The father of a fool has no joy.
22 A cheerful heart makes good medicine,
but a crushed spirit dries up the
bones.
23 A wicked man receives a bribe in secret,
to pervert the ways of justice.
24 Wisdom is before the face of one who
has understanding,
but the eyes of a fool wander to the
ends of the earth.
25 A foolish son brings grief to his father,
and bitterness to her who bore him.
26 Also to punish the righteous is not good,
nor to flog officials for their integrity.
27 He who spares his words has
knowledge.
He who is even tempered is a man of
understanding.
28 Even a fool, when he keeps silent, is
counted wise.
When he shuts his lips, he is thought
to be discerning.

18

1 A man who isolates himself pursues
selfishness,
and defies all sound judgment.
2 A fool has no delight in understanding,
but only in revealing his own opinion.
3 When wickedness comes, contempt also
comes,
and with shame comes disgrace.
4 The words of a man's mouth are like
deep waters.
The fountain of wisdom is like a
flowing brook.
5 To be partial to the faces of the wicked is
not good,
nor to deprive the innocent of justice.
6 A fool's lips come into strife,
and his mouth invites beatings.
7 A fool's mouth is his destruction,
and his lips are a snare to his soul.
8 The words of a gossip are like dainty
morsels:
they go down into a person's
innermost parts.
9 One who is slack in his work
is brother to him who is a master of
destruction.
10 Yahweh's name is a strong tower:
the righteous run to him, and are safe.
11 The rich man's wealth is his strong city,
like an unscalable wall in his own
imagination.
12 Before destruction the heart of man is
proud,
but before honor is humility.
13 He who answers before he hears,
that is folly and shame to him.
14 A man's spirit will sustain him in
sickness,
but a crushed spirit, who can bear?
15 The heart of the discerning gets
knowledge.
The ear of the wise seeks knowledge.
16 A man's gift makes room for him,
and brings him before great men.
17 He who pleads his cause first seems
right—
until another comes and questions
him.
18 The lot settles disputes,
and keeps strong ones apart.
19 A brother offended is more difficult
than a fortified city.
Disputes are like the bars of a fortress.
20 A man's stomach is filled with the fruit
of his mouth.
With the harvest of his lips he is
satisfied.
21 Death and life are in the power of the
tongue;
those who love it will eat its fruit.
22 Whoever finds a wife finds a good thing,
and obtains favor of Yahweh.
23 The poor plead for mercy,
but the rich answer harshly.
24 A man of many companions may be
ruined,
but there is a friend who sticks closer
than a brother.

19

1 Better is the poor who walks in his integrity
than he who is perverse in his lips and is a fool.
2 It isn't good to have zeal without knowledge,
nor to be hasty with one's feet and miss the way.
3 The foolishness of man subverts his way;
his heart rages against Yahweh.
4 Wealth adds many friends,
but the poor is separated from his friend.
5 A false witness shall not be unpunished.
He who pours out lies shall not go free.
6 Many will entreat the favor of a ruler,
and everyone is a friend to a man who gives gifts.
7 All the relatives of the poor shun him;
how much more do his friends avoid him!
He pursues them with pleas, but they are gone.
8 He who gets wisdom loves his own soul.
He who keeps understanding shall find good.
9 A false witness shall not be unpunished.
He who utters lies shall perish.
10 Delicate living is not appropriate for a fool,
much less for a servant to have rule over princes.
11 The discretion of a man makes him slow to anger.
It is his glory to overlook an offense.
12 The king's wrath is like the roaring of a lion,
but his favor is like dew on the grass.
13 A foolish son is the calamity of his father.
A wife's quarrels are a continual dripping.
14 House and riches are an inheritance from fathers,
but a prudent wife is from Yahweh.
15 Slothfulness casts into a deep sleep.
The idle soul shall suffer hunger.
16 He who keeps the commandment keeps his soul,
but he who is contemptuous in his ways shall die.
17 He who has pity on the poor lends to Yahweh;
he will reward him.
18 Discipline your son, for there is hope;
don't be a willing party to his death.
19 A hot-tempered man must pay the penalty,
for if you rescue him, you must do it again.
20 Listen to counsel and receive instruction,
that you may be wise in your latter end.
21 There are many plans in a man's heart,
but Yahweh's counsel will prevail.
22 That which makes a man to be desired is his kindness.
A poor man is better than a liar.
23 The fear of Yahweh leads to life, then contentment;
he rests and will not be touched by trouble.
24 The sluggard buries his hand in the dish;
he will not so much as bring it to his mouth again.
25 Flog a scoffer, and the simple will learn prudence;
rebuke one who has understanding, and he will gain knowledge.
26 He who robs his father and drives away his mother
is a son who causes shame and brings reproach.
27 If you stop listening to instruction, my son,
you will stray from the words of knowledge.
28 A corrupt witness mocks justice,
and the mouth of the wicked gulps down iniquity.
29 Penalties are prepared for scoffers,
and beatings for the backs of fools.

20

1 Wine is a mocker and beer is a brawler.
Whoever is led astray by them is not wise.
2 The terror of a king is like the roaring of a lion.

He who provokes him to anger
forfeits his own life.
3 It is an honor for a man to keep aloof from strife,
but every fool will be quarreling.
4 The sluggard will not plow by reason of the winter;
therefore he shall beg in harvest, and have nothing.
5 Counsel in the heart of man is like deep water,
but a man of understanding will draw it out.
6 Many men claim to be men of unfailing love,
but who can find a faithful man?
7 A righteous man walks in integrity.
Blessed are his children after him.
8 A king who sits on the throne of judgment
scatters away all evil with his eyes.
9 Who can say, “I have made my heart pure.
I am clean and without sin”?
10 Differing weights and differing measures,
both of them alike are an abomination to Yahweh.
11 Even a child makes himself known by his doings,
whether his work is pure, and whether it is right.
12 The hearing ear, and the seeing eye,
Yahweh has made even both of them.
13 Don’t love sleep, lest you come to poverty.
Open your eyes, and you shall be satisfied with bread.
14 “It’s no good, it’s no good,” says the buyer;
but when he is gone his way, then he boasts.
15 There is gold and abundance of rubies,
but the lips of knowledge are a rare jewel.
16 Take the garment of one who puts up collateral for a stranger;
and hold him in pledge for a wayward woman.
17 Fraudulent food is sweet to a man,
but afterwards his mouth is filled with gravel.
18 Plans are established by advice;
by wise guidance you wage war!
19 He who goes about as a tale-bearer reveals secrets;
therefore don’t keep company with him who opens wide his lips.
20 Whoever curses his father or his mother,
his lamp shall be put out in blackness of darkness.
21 An inheritance quickly gained at the beginning
won’t be blessed in the end.
22 Don’t say, “I will pay back evil.”
Wait for Yahweh, and he will save you.
23 Yahweh detests differing weights,
and dishonest scales are not pleasing.
24 A man’s steps are from Yahweh;
how then can man understand his way?
25 It is a snare to a man to make a rash dedication,
then later to consider his vows.
26 A wise king winnows out the wicked,
and drives the threshing wheel over them.
27 The spirit of man is Yahweh’s lamp,
searching all his innermost parts.
28 Love and faithfulness keep the king safe.
His throne is sustained by love.
29 The glory of young men is their strength.
The splendor of old men is their gray hair.
30 Wounding blows cleanse away evil,
and beatings purge the innermost parts.

21

1 The king’s heart is in Yahweh’s hand like the watercourses.
He turns it wherever he desires.
2 Every way of a man is right in his own eyes,
but Yahweh weighs the hearts.
3 To do righteousness and justice
is more acceptable to Yahweh than sacrifice.
4 A high look and a proud heart,
the lamp of the wicked, is sin.

5 The plans of the diligent surely lead to
profit;
and everyone who is hasty surely
rushes to poverty.
6 Getting treasures by a lying tongue
is a fleeting vapor for those who seek
death.
7 The violence of the wicked will drive
them away,
because they refuse to do what is
right.
8 The way of the guilty is devious,
but the conduct of the innocent is
upright.
9 It is better to dwell in the corner of the
housetop
than to share a house with a
contentious woman.
10 The soul of the wicked desires evil;
his neighbor finds no mercy in his
eyes.
11 When the mocker is punished, the
simple gains wisdom.
When the wise is instructed, he
receives knowledge.
12 The Righteous One considers the house
of the wicked,
and brings the wicked to ruin.
13 Whoever stops his ears at the cry of the
poor,
he will also cry out, but shall not be
heard.
14 A gift in secret pacifies anger,
and a bribe in the cloak, strong wrath.
15 It is joy to the righteous to do justice;
but it is a destruction to the workers
of iniquity.
16 The man who wanders out of the way of
understanding
shall rest in the assembly of the
departed spirits.
17 He who loves pleasure will be a poor
man.
He who loves wine and oil won't be
rich.
18 The wicked is a ransom for the
righteous,
the treacherous for the upright.
19 It is better to dwell in a desert land,
than with a contentious and fretful
woman.
20 There is precious treasure and oil in the
dwelling of the wise,
but a foolish man swallows it up.
21 He who follows after righteousness and
kindness
finds life, righteousness, and honor.
22 A wise man scales the city of the mighty,
and brings down the strength of its
confidence.
23 Whoever guards his mouth and his
tongue
keeps his soul from troubles.
24 The proud and arrogant man—"Scoffer"
is his name—
he works in the arrogance of pride.
25 The desire of the sluggard kills him,
for his hands refuse to labor.
26 There are those who covet greedily all
day long;
but the righteous give and don't
withhold.
27 The sacrifice of the wicked is an
abomination—
how much more, when he brings it
with a wicked mind!
28 A false witness will perish.
A man who listens speaks to eternity.
29 A wicked man hardens his face;
but as for the upright, he establishes
his ways.
30 There is no wisdom nor understanding
nor counsel against Yahweh.
31 The horse is prepared for the day of
battle;
but victory is with Yahweh.

22

1 A good name is more desirable than
great riches,
and loving favor is better than silver
and gold.
2 The rich and the poor have this in
common:
Yahweh is the maker of them all.
3 A prudent man sees danger and hides
himself;
but the simple pass on, and suffer for
it.
4 The result of humility and the fear of
Yahweh
is wealth, honor, and life.
5 Thorns and snares are in the path of the
wicked;

whoever guards his soul stays far
from them.
6 Train up a child in the way he should go,
and when he is old he will not depart
from it.
7 The rich rule over the poor.
The borrower is servant to the lender.
8 He who sows wickedness reaps trouble,
and the rod of his fury will be
destroyed.
9 He who has a generous eye will be
blessed,
for he shares his food with the poor.
10 Drive out the mocker, and strife will go
out;
yes, quarrels and insults will stop.
11 He who loves purity of heart and speaks
gracefully
is the king's friend.
12 Yahweh's eyes watch over knowledge,
but he frustrates the words of the
unfaithful.
13 The sluggard says, "There is a lion
outside!
I will be killed in the streets!"
14 The mouth of an adulteress is a deep pit.
He who is under Yahweh's wrath will
fall into it.
15 Folly is bound up in the heart of a child;
the rod of discipline drives it far from
him.
16 Whoever oppresses the poor for his
own increase and whoever gives to
the rich,
both come to poverty.

17 Turn your ear, and listen to the words
of the wise.
Apply your heart to my teaching.
18 For it is a pleasant thing if you keep
them within you,
if all of them are ready on your lips.
19 I teach you today, even you,
so that your trust may be in Yahweh.
20 Haven't I written to you thirty excellent
things
of counsel and knowledge,
21 To teach you truth, reliable words,
to give sound answers to the ones
who sent you?

22 Don't exploit the poor because he is
poor;
and don't crush the needy in court;
23 for Yahweh will plead their case,
and plunder the life of those who
plunder them.

24 Don't befriend a hot-tempered man.
Don't associate with one who harbors
anger,
25 lest you learn his ways
and ensnare your soul.

26 Don't you be one of those who strike
hands,
of those who are collateral for debts.
27 If you don't have means to pay,
why should he take away your bed
from under you?

28 Don't move the ancient boundary stone
which your fathers have set up.

29 Do you see a man skilled in his work?
He will serve kings.
He won't serve obscure men.

23

1 When you sit to eat with a ruler,
consider diligently what is before
you;
2 put a knife to your throat
if you are a man given to appetite.
3 Don't be desirous of his dainties,
since they are deceitful food.
4 Don't weary yourself to be rich.
In your wisdom, show restraint.
5 Why do you set your eyes on that which
is not?
For it certainly sprouts wings like an
eagle and flies in the sky.
6 Don't eat the food of him who has a
stingy eye,
and don't crave his delicacies,
7 for as he thinks about the cost, so he
is.
"Eat and drink!" he says to you,
but his heart is not with you.
8 You will vomit up the morsel which you
have eaten
and waste your pleasant words.

9 Don't speak in the ears of a fool,

for he will despise the wisdom of your
words.

10 Don't move the ancient boundary stone.
Don't encroach on the fields of the
fatherless,
11 for their Defender is strong.
He will plead their case against you.

12 Apply your heart to instruction,
and your ears to the words of
knowledge.
13 Don't withhold correction from a child.
If you punish him with the rod, he
will not die.
14 Punish him with the rod,
and save his soul from Sheol.†

15 My son, if your heart is wise,
then my heart will be glad, even mine.
16 Yes, my heart will rejoice
when your lips speak what is right.
17 Don't let your heart envy sinners,
but rather fear Yahweh all day long.
18 Indeed surely there is a future hope,
and your hope will not be cut off.
19 Listen, my son, and be wise,
and keep your heart on the right path!
20 Don't be among ones drinking too much
wine,
or those who gorge themselves on
meat;
21 for the drunkard and the glutton shall
become poor;
and drowsiness clothes them in rags.
22 Listen to your father who gave you life,
and don't despise your mother when
she is old.
23 Buy the truth, and don't sell it.
Get wisdom, discipline, and
understanding.
24 The father of the righteous has great joy.
Whoever fathers a wise child delights
in him.
25 Let your father and your mother be
glad!
Let her who bore you rejoice!
26 My son, give me your heart;
and let your eyes keep in my ways.
27 For a prostitute is a deep pit;
and a wayward wife is a narrow well.
28 Yes, she lies in wait like a robber,
and increases the unfaithful among
men.

29 Who has woe?
Who has sorrow?
Who has strife?
Who has complaints?
Who has needless bruises?
Who has bloodshot eyes?
30 Those who stay long at the wine;
those who go to seek out mixed wine.
31 Don't look at the wine when it is red,
when it sparkles in the cup,
when it goes down smoothly.
32 In the end, it bites like a snake,
and poisons like a viper.
33 Your eyes will see strange things,
and your mind will imagine
confusing things.
34 Yes, you will be as he who lies down in
the middle of the sea,
or as he who lies on top of the rigging:
35 "They hit me, and I was not hurt!
They beat me, and I don't feel it!
When will I wake up? I can do it
again.
I will look for more."

24

1 Don't be envious of evil men,
neither desire to be with them;
2 for their hearts plot violence
and their lips talk about mischief.
3 Through wisdom a house is built;
by understanding it is established;
4 by knowledge the rooms are filled
with all rare and beautiful treasure.
5 A wise man has great power.
A knowledgeable man increases
strength,
6 for by wise guidance you wage your war,
and victory is in many advisors.
7 Wisdom is too high for a fool.
He doesn't open his mouth in the gate.
8 One who plots to do evil
will be called a schemer.
9 The schemes of folly are sin.
The mocker is detested by men.
10 If you falter in the time of trouble,

† **23:14** Sheol is the place of the dead.

your strength is small.
11 Rescue those who are being led away to death!
Indeed, hold back those who are staggering to the slaughter!
12 If you say, “Behold, we didn’t know this,”
doesn’t he who weighs the hearts consider it?
He who keeps your soul, doesn’t he know it?
Shall he not give to every man according to his work?
13 My son, eat honey, for it is good,
the droppings of the honeycomb, which are sweet to your taste;
14 so you shall know wisdom to be to your soul.
If you have found it, then there will be a reward:
Your hope will not be cut off.
15 Don’t lay in wait, wicked man, against the habitation of the righteous.
Don’t destroy his resting place;
16 for a righteous man falls seven times and rises up again,
but the wicked are overthrown by calamity.
17 Don’t rejoice when your enemy falls.
Don’t let your heart be glad when he is overthrown,
18 lest Yahweh see it, and it displease him,
and he turn away his wrath from him.
19 Don’t fret yourself because of evildoers,
neither be envious of the wicked;
20 for there will be no reward to the evil man.
The lamp of the wicked will be snuffed out.
21 My son, fear Yahweh and the king.
Don’t join those who are rebellious,
22 for their calamity will rise suddenly.
Who knows what destruction may come from them both?

23 These also are sayings of the wise:

To show partiality in judgment is not good.
24 He who says to the wicked, “You are righteous,”
peoples will curse him, and nations will abhor him—
25 but it will go well with those who convict the guilty,
and a rich blessing will come on them.
26 An honest answer
is like a kiss on the lips.
27 Prepare your work outside,
and get your fields ready.
Afterwards, build your house.
28 Don’t be a witness against your neighbor without cause.
Don’t deceive with your lips.
29 Don’t say, “I will do to him as he has done to me;
I will repay the man according to his work.”
30 I went by the field of the sluggard,
by the vineyard of the man void of understanding.
31 Behold, it was all grown over with thorns.
Its surface was covered with nettles,
and its stone wall was broken down.
32 Then I saw, and considered well.
I saw, and received instruction:
33 a little sleep, a little slumber,
a little folding of the hands to sleep,
34 so your poverty will come as a robber
and your want as an armed man.

25

1 These also are proverbs of Solomon, which the men of Hezekiah king of Judah copied out.
2 It is the glory of God to conceal a thing,
but the glory of kings is to search out a matter.
3 As the heavens for height, and the earth for depth,
so the hearts of kings are unsearchable.
4 Take away the dross from the silver,
and material comes out for the refiner.
5 Take away the wicked from the king’s presence,
and his throne will be established in righteousness.
6 Don’t exalt yourself in the presence of the king,
or claim a place among great men;

7 for it is better that it be said to you,
“Come up here,”
than that you should be put lower in the presence of the prince,
whom your eyes have seen.
8 Don’t be hasty in bringing charges to court.
What will you do in the end when your neighbor shames you?
9 Debate your case with your neighbor,
and don’t betray the confidence of another,
10 lest one who hears it put you to shame,
and your bad reputation never depart.

11 A word fitly spoken
is like apples of gold in settings of silver.
12 As an earring of gold, and an ornament of fine gold,
so is a wise reprover to an obedient ear.
13 As the cold of snow in the time of harvest,
so is a faithful messenger to those who send him;
for he refreshes the soul of his masters.
14 As clouds and wind without rain,
so is he who boasts of gifts deceptively.
15 By patience a ruler is persuaded.
A soft tongue breaks the bone.
16 Have you found honey?
Eat as much as is sufficient for you,
lest you eat too much, and vomit it.
17 Let your foot be seldom in your neighbor’s house,
lest he be weary of you, and hate you.
18 A man who gives false testimony against his neighbor
is like a club, a sword, or a sharp arrow.
19 Confidence in someone unfaithful in time of trouble
is like a bad tooth or a lame foot.
20 As one who takes away a garment in cold weather,
or vinegar on soda,
so is one who sings songs to a heavy heart.
21 If your enemy is hungry, give him food to eat.
If he is thirsty, give him water to drink;
22 for you will heap coals of fire on his head,
and Yahweh will reward you.
23 The north wind produces rain;
so a backbiting tongue brings an angry face.
24 It is better to dwell in the corner of the housetop
than to share a house with a contentious woman.
25 Like cold water to a thirsty soul,
so is good news from a far country.
26 Like a muddied spring and a polluted well,
so is a righteous man who gives way before the wicked.
27 It is not good to eat much honey,
nor is it honorable to seek one’s own honor.
28 Like a city that is broken down and without walls
is a man whose spirit is without restraint.

26

1 Like snow in summer, and as rain in harvest,
so honor is not fitting for a fool.
2 Like a fluttering sparrow,
like a darting swallow,
so the undeserved curse doesn’t come to rest.
3 A whip is for the horse,
a bridle for the donkey,
and a rod for the back of fools!
4 Don’t answer a fool according to his folly,
lest you also be like him.
5 Answer a fool according to his folly,
lest he be wise in his own eyes.
6 One who sends a message by the hand of a fool
is cutting off feet and drinking violence.
7 Like the legs of the lame that hang loose,
so is a parable in the mouth of fools.
8 As one who binds a stone in a sling,
so is he who gives honor to a fool.
9 Like a thorn bush that goes into the hand of a drunkard,

so is a parable in the mouth of fools.
10 As an archer who wounds all,
so is he who hires a fool
or he who hires those who pass by.
11 As a dog that returns to his vomit,
so is a fool who repeats his folly.
12 Do you see a man wise in his own eyes?
There is more hope for a fool than for him.
13 The sluggard says, “There is a lion in the road!
A fierce lion roams the streets!”
14 As the door turns on its hinges,
so does the sluggard on his bed.
15 The sluggard buries his hand in the dish.
He is too lazy to bring it back to his mouth.
16 The sluggard is wiser in his own eyes
than seven men who answer with discretion.
17 Like one who grabs a dog’s ears
is one who passes by and meddles in a quarrel not his own.
18 Like a madman who shoots torches, arrows, and death,
19 is the man who deceives his neighbor and says, “Am I not joking?”
20 For lack of wood a fire goes out.
Without gossip, a quarrel dies down.
21 As coals are to hot embers,
and wood to fire,
so is a contentious man to kindling strife.
22 The words of a whisperer are as dainty morsels,
they go down into the innermost parts.
23 Like silver dross on an earthen vessel
are the lips of a fervent one with an evil heart.
24 A malicious man disguises himself with his lips,
but he harbors evil in his heart.
25 When his speech is charming, don’t believe him,
for there are seven abominations in his heart.
26 His malice may be concealed by deception,
but his wickedness will be exposed in the assembly.
27 Whoever digs a pit shall fall into it.
Whoever rolls a stone, it will come back on him.
28 A lying tongue hates those it hurts;
and a flattering mouth works ruin.

27

1 Don’t boast about tomorrow;
for you don’t know what a day may bring.
2 Let another man praise you,
and not your own mouth;
a stranger, and not your own lips.
3 A stone is heavy,
and sand is a burden;
but a fool’s provocation is heavier than both.
4 Wrath is cruel,
and anger is overwhelming;
but who is able to stand before jealousy?
5 Better is open rebuke
than hidden love.
6 The wounds of a friend are faithful,
although the kisses of an enemy are profuse.
7 A full soul loathes a honeycomb;
but to a hungry soul, every bitter thing is sweet.
8 As a bird that wanders from her nest,
so is a man who wanders from his home.
9 Perfume and incense bring joy to the heart;
so does earnest counsel from a man’s friend.
10 Don’t forsake your friend and your father’s friend.
Don’t go to your brother’s house in the day of your disaster.
A neighbor who is near is better than a distant brother.
11 Be wise, my son,
and bring joy to my heart,
then I can answer my tormentor.
12 A prudent man sees danger and takes refuge;
but the simple pass on, and suffer for it.
13 Take his garment when he puts up collateral for a stranger.
Hold it for a wayward woman!

14 He who blesses his neighbor with a loud
voice early in the morning,
it will be taken as a curse by him.
15 A continual dropping on a rainy day
and a contentious wife are alike:
16 restraining her is like restraining the
wind,
or like grasping oil in his right hand.

17 Iron sharpens iron;
so a man sharpens his friend's
countenance.
18 Whoever tends the fig tree shall eat its
fruit.
He who looks after his master shall be
honored.
19 Like water reflects a face,
so a man's heart reflects the man.
20 Sheol† and Abaddon are never satisfied;
and a man's eyes are never satisfied.
21 The crucible is for silver,
and the furnace for gold;
but man is refined by his praise.
22 Though you grind a fool in a mortar
with a pestle along with grain,
yet his foolishness will not be
removed from him.

23 Know well the state of your flocks,
and pay attention to your herds,
24 for riches are not forever,
nor does the crown endure to all
generations.
25 The hay is removed, and the new
growth appears,
the grasses of the hills are gathered in.
26 The lambs are for your clothing,
and the goats are the price of a field.
27 There will be plenty of goats' milk for
your food,
for your family's food,
and for the nourishment of your
servant girls.

28

1 The wicked flee when no one pursues;
but the righteous are as bold as a lion.
2 In rebellion, a land has many rulers,
but order is maintained by a man of
understanding and knowledge.
3 A needy man who oppresses the poor
is like a driving rain which leaves no
crops.
4 Those who forsake the law praise the
wicked;
but those who keep the law contend
with them.
5 Evil men don't understand justice;
but those who seek Yahweh
understand it fully.
6 Better is the poor who walks in his
integrity
than he who is perverse in his ways,
and he is rich.
7 Whoever keeps the law is a wise son;
but he who is a companion of gluttons
shames his father.
8 He who increases his wealth by
excessive interest
gathers it for one who has pity on the
poor.
9 He who turns away his ear from hearing
the law,
even his prayer is an abomination.
10 Whoever causes the upright to go astray
in an evil way,
he will fall into his own trap;
but the blameless will inherit good.
11 The rich man is wise in his own eyes;
but the poor who has understanding
sees through him.
12 When the righteous triumph, there is
great glory;
but when the wicked rise, men hide
themselves.
13 He who conceals his sins doesn't
prosper,
but whoever confesses and
renounces them finds mercy.
14 Blessed is the man who always fears;
but one who hardens his heart falls
into trouble.
15 As a roaring lion or a charging bear,
so is a wicked ruler over helpless
people.
16 A tyrannical ruler lacks judgment.
One who hates ill-gotten gain will
have long days.
17 A man who is tormented by blood guilt
will be a fugitive until death.
No one will support him.
18 Whoever walks blamelessly is kept safe;

† **27:20** Sheol is the place of the dead.

but one with perverse ways will fall
suddenly.
19 One who works his land will have an
abundance of food;
but one who chases fantasies will
have his fill of poverty.
20 A faithful man is rich with blessings;
but one who is eager to be rich will
not go unpunished.
21 To show partiality is not good,
yet a man will do wrong for a piece of
bread.
22 A stingy man hurries after riches,
and doesn't know that poverty waits
for him.
23 One who rebukes a man will afterward
find more favor
than one who flatters with the tongue.
24 Whoever robs his father or his mother
and says, "It's not wrong,"
is a partner with a destroyer.
25 One who is greedy stirs up strife;
but one who trusts in Yahweh will
prosper.
26 One who trusts in himself is a fool;
but one who walks in wisdom is kept
safe.
27 One who gives to the poor has no lack;
but one who closes his eyes will have
many curses.
28 When the wicked rise, men hide
themselves;
but when they perish, the righteous
thrive.

29

1 He who is often rebuked and stiffens his
neck
will be destroyed suddenly, with no
remedy.
2 When the righteous thrive, the people
rejoice;
but when the wicked rule, the people
groan.
3 Whoever loves wisdom brings joy to his
father;
but a companion of prostitutes
squanders his wealth.
4 The king by justice makes the land stable,
but he who takes bribes tears it down.
5 A man who flatters his neighbor
spreads a net for his feet.
6 An evil man is snared by his sin,
but the righteous can sing and be
glad.
7 The righteous care about justice for the
poor.
The wicked aren't concerned about
knowledge.
8 Mockers stir up a city,
but wise men turn away anger.
9 If a wise man goes to court with a foolish
man,
the fool rages or scoffs, and there is
no peace.
10 The bloodthirsty hate a man of
integrity;
and they seek the life of the upright.
11 A fool vents all of his anger,
but a wise man brings himself under
control.
12 If a ruler listens to lies,
all of his officials are wicked.
13 The poor man and the oppressor have
this in common:
Yahweh gives sight to the eyes of both.
14 The king who fairly judges the poor,
his throne shall be established
forever.
15 The rod of correction gives wisdom,
but a child left to himself causes
shame to his mother.
16 When the wicked increase, sin
increases;
but the righteous will see their
downfall.
17 Correct your son, and he will give you
peace;
yes, he will bring delight to your soul.
18 Where there is no revelation, the people
cast off restraint;
but one who keeps the law is blessed.
19 A servant can't be corrected by words.
Though he understands, yet he will
not respond.
20 Do you see a man who is hasty in his
words?
There is more hope for a fool than for
him.
21 He who pampers his servant from
youth
will have him become a son in the
end.
22 An angry man stirs up strife,
and a wrathful man abounds in sin.
23 A man's pride brings him low,
but one of lowly spirit gains honor.

24 Whoever is an accomplice of a thief is
an enemy of his own soul.
He takes an oath, but dares not testify.
25 The fear of man proves to be a snare,
but whoever puts his trust in Yahweh
is kept safe.
26 Many seek the ruler's favor,
but a man's justice comes from
Yahweh.
27 A dishonest man detests the righteous,
and the upright in their ways detest
the wicked.

30

1 The words of Agur the son of Jakeh, the
revelation:
the man says to Ithiel,
to Ithiel and Ucal:
2 "Surely I am the most ignorant man,
and don't have a man's
understanding.
3 I have not learned wisdom,
neither do I have the knowledge of
the Holy One.
4 Who has ascended up into heaven, and
descended?
Who has gathered the wind in his
fists?
Who has bound the waters in his
garment?
Who has established all the ends of
the earth?
What is his name, and what is his
son's name, if you know?

5 "Every word of God is flawless.
He is a shield to those who take refuge
in him.
6 Don't you add to his words,
lest he reprove you, and you be found
a liar.

7 "Two things I have asked of you.
Don't deny me before I die.
8 Remove far from me falsehood and lies.
Give me neither poverty nor riches.
Feed me with the food that is needful
for me,
9 lest I be full, deny you, and say, 'Who is
Yahweh?'
or lest I be poor, and steal,
and so dishonor the name of my God.

10 "Don't slander a servant to his master,
lest he curse you, and you be held
guilty.

11 There is a generation that curses their
father,
and doesn't bless their mother.
12 There is a generation that is pure in
their own eyes,
yet are not washed from their
filthiness.
13 There is a generation, oh how lofty are
their eyes!
Their eyelids are lifted up.
14 There is a generation whose teeth are
like swords,
and their jaws like knives,
to devour the poor from the earth,
and the needy from among men.

15 "The leech has two daughters:
'Give, give.'

"There are three things that are never
satisfied;
four that don't say, 'Enough!':
16 Sheol,†
the barren womb,
the earth that is not satisfied with
water,
and the fire that doesn't say, 'Enough!'

17 "The eye that mocks at his father,
and scorns obedience to his mother,
the ravens of the valley shall pick it
out,
the young eagles shall eat it.

18 "There are three things which are too
amazing for me,
four which I don't understand:
19 The way of an eagle in the air,
the way of a serpent on a rock,
the way of a ship in the middle of the
sea,
and the way of a man with a maiden.

20 "So is the way of an adulterous woman:
She eats and wipes her mouth,
and says, 'I have done nothing wrong.'

21 "For three things the earth trembles,

† **30:16** Sheol is the place of the dead.

and under four, it can't bear up:
22 For a servant when he is king,
a fool when he is filled with food,
23 for an unloved woman when she is married,
and a servant who is heir to her mistress.

24 "There are four things which are little on the earth,
but they are exceedingly wise:
25 The ants are not a strong people,
yet they provide their food in the summer.
26 The hyraxes are but a feeble folk,
yet make they their houses in the rocks.
27 The locusts have no king,
yet they advance in ranks.
28 You can catch a lizard with your hands,
yet it is in kings' palaces.

29 "There are three things which are stately in their march,
four which are stately in going:
30 The lion, which is mightiest among animals,
and doesn't turn away for any;
31 the greyhound;
the male goat;
and the king against whom there is no rising up.

32 "If you have done foolishly in lifting up yourself,
or if you have thought evil,
put your hand over your mouth.
33 For as the churning of milk produces butter,
and the wringing of the nose produces blood,
so the forcing of wrath produces strife."

31

1 The words of King Lemuel—the revelation which his mother taught him:

2 "Oh, my son!
Oh, son of my womb!
Oh, son of my vows!
3 Don't give your strength to women,
nor your ways to that which destroys kings.
4 It is not for kings, Lemuel,
it is not for kings to drink wine,
nor for princes to say, 'Where is strong drink?'
5 lest they drink, and forget the law,
and pervert the justice due to anyone who is afflicted.
6 Give strong drink to him who is ready to perish,
and wine to the bitter in soul.
7 Let him drink, and forget his poverty,
and remember his misery no more.
8 Open your mouth for the mute,
in the cause of all who are left desolate.
9 Open your mouth, judge righteously,
and serve justice to the poor and needy."

10 †Who can find a worthy woman?
For her value is far above rubies.
11 The heart of her husband trusts in her.
He shall have no lack of gain.
12 She does him good, and not harm,
all the days of her life.
13 She seeks wool and flax,
and works eagerly with her hands.
14 She is like the merchant ships.
She brings her bread from afar.
15 She rises also while it is yet night,
gives food to her household,
and portions for her servant girls.
16 She considers a field, and buys it.
With the fruit of her hands, she plants a vineyard.
17 She arms her waist with strength,
and makes her arms strong.
18 She perceives that her merchandise is profitable.
Her lamp doesn't go out by night.
19 She lays her hands to the distaff,
and her hands hold the spindle.
20 She opens her arms to the poor;
yes, she extends her hands to the needy.

† **31:10** Proverbs 31:10-31 form an acrostic, with each verse starting with each letter of the Hebrew alphabet, in order.

21 She is not afraid of the snow for her
household,
for all her household are clothed with
scarlet.
22 She makes for herself carpets of
tapestry.
Her clothing is fine linen and purple.
23 Her husband is respected in the gates,
when he sits among the elders of the
land.
24 She makes linen garments and sells
them,
and delivers sashes to the merchant.
25 Strength and dignity are her clothing.
She laughs at the time to come.
26 She opens her mouth with wisdom.
Kind instruction is on her tongue.
27 She looks well to the ways of her
household,
and doesn't eat the bread of idleness.
28 Her children rise up and call her
blessed.
Her husband also praises her:
29 "Many women do noble things,
but you excel them all."
30 Charm is deceitful, and beauty is vain;
but a woman who fears Yahweh, she
shall be praised.
31 Give her of the fruit of her hands!
Let her works praise her in the gates!

Ecclesiastes
or, The Preacher

1 The words of the Preacher, the son of
David, king in Jerusalem:
2 "Vanity of vanities," says the Preacher;
"Vanity of vanities, all is vanity."
3 What does man gain from all his labor
in which he labors under the sun?
4 One generation goes, and another
generation comes; but the earth remains
forever.
5 The sun also rises, and the sun goes
down, and hurries to its place where it
rises.
6 The wind goes toward the south, and
turns around to the north. It turns around
continually as it goes, and the wind
returns again to its courses.
7 All the rivers run into the sea, yet the
sea is not full. To the place where the
rivers flow, there they flow again.
8 All things are full of weariness beyond
uttering. The eye is not satisfied with
seeing, nor the ear filled with hearing.
9 That which has been is that which
shall be, and that which has been done is
that which shall be done; and there is no
new thing under the sun.
10 Is there a thing of which it may be
said, "Behold,† this is new"? It has been
long ago, in the ages which were before
us.
11 There is no memory of the former;
neither shall there be any memory of the
latter that are to come, among those that
shall come after.
12 I, the Preacher, was king over Israel
in Jerusalem.
13 I applied my heart to seek and to
search out by wisdom concerning all that
is done under the sky. It is a heavy burden
that God‡ has given to the sons of men to
be afflicted with.
14 I have seen all the works that are
done under the sun; and behold, all is
vanity and a chasing after wind.
15 That which is crooked can't be made
straight; and that which is lacking can't be
counted.
16 I said to myself, "Behold, I have
obtained for myself great wisdom above
all who were before me in Jerusalem. Yes,
my heart has had great experience of
wisdom and knowledge."
17 I applied my heart to know wisdom,
and to know madness and folly. I
perceived that this also was a chasing
after wind.
18 For in much wisdom is much grief;
and he who increases knowledge
increases sorrow.

2

1 I said in my heart, "Come now, I will
test you with mirth; therefore enjoy
pleasure;" and behold, this also was
vanity.
2 I said of laughter, "It is foolishness;"
and of mirth, "What does it accomplish?"
3 I searched in my heart how to cheer
my flesh with wine, my heart yet guiding
me with wisdom, and how to lay hold of
folly, until I might see what it was good
for the sons of men that they should do
under heaven all the days of their lives.
4 I made myself great works. I built
myself houses. I planted myself
vineyards.
5 I made myself gardens and parks, and
I planted trees in them of all kinds of fruit.
6 I made myself pools of water, to water
the forest where trees were grown.
7 I bought male servants and female
servants, and had servants born in my
house. I also had great possessions of
herds and flocks, above all who were
before me in Jerusalem.
8 I also gathered silver and gold for
myself, and the treasure of kings and of
the provinces. I got myself male and
female singers, and the delights of the
sons of men: musical instruments of all
sorts.

† **1:10** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
‡ **1:13** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

9 So I was great, and increased more
than all who were before me in Jerusalem.
My wisdom also remained with me.
10 Whatever my eyes desired, I didn't
keep from them. I didn't withhold my
heart from any joy, for my heart rejoiced
because of all my labor, and this was my
portion from all my labor.
11 Then I looked at all the works that my
hands had worked, and at the labor that I
had labored to do; and behold, all was
vanity and a chasing after wind, and there
was no profit under the sun.
12 I turned myself to consider wisdom,
madness, and folly; for what can the
king's successor do? Just that which has
been done long ago.
13 Then I saw that wisdom excels folly,
as far as light excels darkness.
14 The wise man's eyes are in his head,
and the fool walks in darkness—and yet I
perceived that one event happens to them
all.
15 Then I said in my heart, "As it happens
to the fool, so will it happen even to me;
and why was I then more wise?" Then I
said in my heart that this also is vanity.
16 For of the wise man, even as of the
fool, there is no memory forever, since in
the days to come all will have been long
forgotten. Indeed, the wise man must die
just like the fool!
17 So I hated life, because the work that
is worked under the sun was grievous to
me; for all is vanity and a chasing after
wind.
18 I hated all my labor in which I
labored under the sun, because I must
leave it to the man who comes after me.
19 Who knows whether he will be a wise
man or a fool? Yet he will have rule over
all of my labor in which I have labored,
and in which I have shown myself wise
under the sun. This also is vanity.
20 Therefore I began to cause my heart
to despair concerning all the labor in
which I had labored under the sun.
21 For there is a man whose labor is with
wisdom, with knowledge, and with
skillfulness; yet he shall leave it for his
portion to a man who has not labored for
it. This also is vanity and a great evil.
22 For what does a man have of all his
labor and of the striving of his heart, in
which he labors under the sun?
23 For all his days are sorrows, and his
travail is grief; yes, even in the night his
heart takes no rest. This also is vanity.
24 There is nothing better for a man
than that he should eat and drink, and
make his soul enjoy good in his labor. This
also I saw, that it is from the hand of God.
25 For who can eat, or who can have
enjoyment, more than I?
26 For to the man who pleases him, God
gives wisdom, knowledge, and joy; but to
the sinner he gives travail, to gather and
to heap up, that he may give to him who
pleases God. This also is vanity and a
chasing after wind.

3

1 For everything there is a season, and a
time for every purpose under heaven:
2 a time to be born,
and a time to die;
a time to plant,
and a time to pluck up that which is
planted;
3 a time to kill,
and a time to heal;
a time to break down,
and a time to build up;
4 a time to weep,
and a time to laugh;
a time to mourn,
and a time to dance;
5 a time to cast away stones,
and a time to gather stones together;
a time to embrace,
and a time to refrain from embracing;
6 a time to seek,
and a time to lose;
a time to keep,
and a time to cast away;
7 a time to tear,
and a time to sew;
a time to keep silence,
and a time to speak;
8 a time to love,
and a time to hate;
a time for war,
and a time for peace.

9 What profit has he who works in that
in which he labors?
10 I have seen the burden which God has
given to the sons of men to be afflicted
with.
11 He has made everything beautiful in
its time. He has also set eternity in their
hearts, yet so that man can't find out the
work that God has done from the
beginning even to the end.
12 I know that there is nothing better for
them than to rejoice, and to do good as
long as they live.
13 Also that every man should eat and
drink, and enjoy good in all his labor, is
the gift of God.
14 I know that whatever God does, it
shall be forever. Nothing can be added to
it, nor anything taken from it; and God has
done it, that men should fear before him.
15 That which is has been long ago, and
that which is to be has been long ago. God
seeks again that which is passed away.
16 Moreover I saw under the sun, in the
place of justice, that wickedness was
there; and in the place of righteousness,
that wickedness was there.
17 I said in my heart, "God will judge the
righteous and the wicked; for there is a
time there for every purpose and for
every work."
18 I said in my heart, "As for the sons of
men, God tests them, so that they may see
that they themselves are like animals.
19 For that which happens to the sons of
men happens to animals. Even one thing
happens to them. As the one dies, so the
other dies. Yes, they have all one breath;
and man has no advantage over the
animals, for all is vanity.
20 All go to one place. All are from the
dust, and all turn to dust again.
21 Who knows the spirit of man,
whether it goes upward, and the spirit of
the animal, whether it goes downward to
the earth?"
22 Therefore I saw that there is nothing
better than that a man should rejoice in
his works, for that is his portion; for who
can bring him to see what will be after
him?

4

1 Then I returned and saw all the
oppressions that are done under the sun:
and behold, the tears of those who were
oppressed, and they had no comforter;
and on the side of their oppressors there
was power; but they had no comforter.
2 Therefore I praised the dead who have
been long dead more than the living who
are yet alive.
3 Yes, better than them both is him who
has not yet been, who has not seen the evil
work that is done under the sun.
4 Then I saw all the labor and
achievement that is the envy of a man's
neighbor. This also is vanity and a
striving after wind.
5 The fool folds his hands together and
ruins himself.
6 Better is a handful, with quietness,
than two handfuls with labor and chasing
after wind.
7 Then I returned and saw vanity under
the sun.
8 There is one who is alone, and he has
neither son nor brother. There is no end
to all of his labor, neither are his eyes
satisfied with wealth. "For whom then do
I labor and deprive my soul of
enjoyment?" This also is vanity. Yes, it is a
miserable business.
9 Two are better than one, because they
have a good reward for their labor.
10 For if they fall, the one will lift up his
fellow; but woe to him who is alone when
he falls, and doesn't have another to lift
him up.
11 Again, if two lie together, then they
have warmth; but how can one keep
warm alone?
12 If a man prevails against one who is
alone, two shall withstand him; and a
threefold cord is not quickly broken.
13 Better is a poor and wise youth than
an old and foolish king who doesn't know
how to receive admonition any more.
14 For out of prison he came out to be
king; yes, even in his kingdom he was
born poor.
15 I saw all the living who walk under
the sun, that they were with the youth, the
other, who succeeded him.

16 There was no end of all the people,
even of all them over whom he was—yet
those who come after shall not rejoice in
him. Surely this also is vanity and a
chasing after wind.

5

1 Guard your steps when you go to God's
house; for to draw near to listen is better
than to give the sacrifice of fools, for they
don't know that they do evil.
2 Don't be rash with your mouth, and
don't let your heart be hasty to utter
anything before God; for God is in heaven,
and you on earth. Therefore let your
words be few.
3 For as a dream comes with a multitude
of cares, so a fool's speech with a
multitude of words.
4 When you vow a vow to God, don't
defer to pay it; for he has no pleasure in
fools. Pay that which you vow.
5 It is better that you should not vow,
than that you should vow and not pay.
6 Don't allow your mouth to lead you
into sin. Don't protest before the
messenger that this was a mistake. Why
should God be angry at your voice, and
destroy the work of your hands?
7 For in the multitude of dreams there
are vanities, as well as in many words; but
you must fear God.
8 If you see the oppression of the poor,
and the violent taking away of justice and
righteousness in a district, don't marvel at
the matter, for one official is eyed by a
higher one, and there are officials over
them.
9 Moreover the profit of the earth is for
all. The king profits from the field.
10 He who loves silver shall not be
satisfied with silver, nor he who loves
abundance, with increase. This also is
vanity.
11 When goods increase, those who eat
them are increased; and what advantage
is there to its owner, except to feast on
them with his eyes?
12 The sleep of a laboring man is sweet,
whether he eats little or much; but the
abundance of the rich will not allow him
to sleep.
13 There is a grievous evil which I have
seen under the sun: wealth kept by its
owner to his harm.
14 Those riches perish by misfortune,
and if he has fathered a son, there is
nothing in his hand.
15 As he came out of his mother's womb,
naked shall he go again as he came, and
shall take nothing for his labor, which he
may carry away in his hand.
16 This also is a grievous evil, that in all
points as he came, so shall he go. And
what profit does he have who labors for
the wind?
17 All his days he also eats in darkness,
he is frustrated, and has sickness and
wrath.
18 Behold, that which I have seen to be
good and proper is for one to eat and to
drink, and to enjoy good in all his labor, in
which he labors under the sun, all the
days of his life which God has given him;
for this is his portion.
19 Every man also to whom God has
given riches and wealth, and has given
him power to eat of it, and to take his
portion, and to rejoice in his labor—this is
the gift of God.
20 For he shall not often reflect on the
days of his life, because God occupies him
with the joy of his heart.

6

1 There is an evil which I have seen
under the sun, and it is heavy on men:
2 a man to whom God gives riches,
wealth, and honor, so that he lacks
nothing for his soul of all that he desires,
yet God gives him no power to eat of it,
but an alien eats it. This is vanity, and it is
an evil disease.
3 If a man fathers a hundred children,
and lives many years, so that the days of
his years are many, but his soul is not
filled with good, and moreover he has no
burial, I say that a stillborn child is better
than he;
4 for it comes in vanity, and departs in
darkness, and its name is covered with
darkness.
5 Moreover it has not seen the sun nor
known it. This has rest rather than the
other.

6 Yes, though he live a thousand years
twice told, and yet fails to enjoy good,
don't all go to one place?
7 All the labor of man is for his mouth,
and yet the appetite is not filled.
8 For what advantage has the wise more
than the fool? What has the poor man,
that knows how to walk before the living?
9 Better is the sight of the eyes than the
wandering of the desire. This also is
vanity and a chasing after wind.
10 Whatever has been, its name was
given long ago; and it is known what man
is; neither can he contend with him who is
mightier than he.
11 For there are many words that create
vanity. What does that profit man?
12 For who knows what is good for man
in life, all the days of his vain life which he
spends like a shadow? For who can tell a
man what will be after him under the
sun?

7

1 A good name is better than fine
perfume; and the day of death better than
the day of one's birth.
2 It is better to go to the house of
mourning than to go to the house of
feasting; for that is the end of all men, and
the living should take this to heart.
3 Sorrow is better than laughter; for by
the sadness of the face the heart is made
good.
4 The heart of the wise is in the house of
mourning; but the heart of fools is in the
house of mirth.
5 It is better to hear the rebuke of the
wise than for a man to hear the song of
fools.
6 For as the crackling of thorns under a
pot, so is the laughter of the fool. This also
is vanity.
7 Surely extortion makes the wise man
foolish; and a bribe destroys the
understanding.
8 Better is the end of a thing than its
beginning.

The patient in spirit is better than the
proud in spirit.

9 Don't be hasty in your spirit to be
angry, for anger rests in the bosom of
fools.
10 Don't say, "Why were the former days
better than these?" For you do not ask
wisely about this.
11 Wisdom is as good as an inheritance.
Yes, it is more excellent for those who see
the sun.
12 For wisdom is a defense, even as
money is a defense; but the excellency of
knowledge is that wisdom preserves the
life of him who has it.
13 Consider the work of God, for who
can make that straight which he has made
crooked?
14 In the day of prosperity be joyful, and
in the day of adversity consider; yes, God
has made the one side by side with the
other, to the end that man should not find
out anything after him.
15 All this I have seen in my days of
vanity: there is a righteous man who
perishes in his righteousness, and there is
a wicked man who lives long in his
evildoing.
16 Don't be overly righteous, neither
make yourself overly wise. Why should
you destroy yourself?
17 Don't be too wicked, neither be
foolish. Why should you die before your
time?
18 It is good that you should take hold of
this. Yes, also don't withdraw your hand
from that; for he who fears God will come
out of them all.
19 Wisdom is a strength to the wise man
more than ten rulers who are in a city.
20 Surely there is not a righteous man on
earth who does good and doesn't sin.
21 Also don't take heed to all words that
are spoken, lest you hear your servant
curse you;
22 for often your own heart knows that
you yourself have likewise cursed others.
23 All this I have proved in wisdom. I
said, "I will be wise;" but it was far from
me.
24 That which is, is far off and
exceedingly deep. Who can find it out?
25 I turned around, and my heart sought
to know and to search out, and to seek

wisdom and the scheme of things, and to know that wickedness is stupidity, and that foolishness is madness.
26 I find more bitter than death the woman whose heart is snares and traps, whose hands are chains. Whoever pleases God shall escape from her; but the sinner will be ensnared by her.
27 "Behold, I have found this," says the Preacher, "to one another, to find an explanation
28 which my soul still seeks, but I have not found. I have found one man among a thousand, but I have not found a woman among all those.
29 Behold, I have only found this: that God made mankind upright; but they search for many inventions."

8

1 Who is like the wise man? And who knows the interpretation of a thing? A man's wisdom makes his face shine, and the hardness of his face is changed.
2 I say, "Keep the king's command!" because of the oath to God.
3 Don't be hasty to go out of his presence. Don't persist in an evil thing, for he does whatever pleases him,
4 for the king's word is supreme. Who can say to him, "What are you doing?"
5 Whoever keeps the commandment shall not come to harm, and his wise heart will know the time and procedure.
6 For there is a time and procedure for every purpose, although the misery of man is heavy on him.
7 For he doesn't know that which will be; for who can tell him how it will be?
8 There is no man who has power over the spirit to contain the spirit; neither does he have power over the day of death. There is no discharge in war; neither shall wickedness deliver those who practice it.
9 All this I have seen, and applied my mind to every work that is done under the sun. There is a time in which one man has power over another to his hurt.
10 So I saw the wicked buried. Indeed they came also from holiness. They went and were forgotten in the city where they did this. This also is vanity.
11 Because sentence against an evil work is not executed speedily, therefore the heart of the sons of men is fully set in them to do evil.
12 Though a sinner commits crimes a hundred times, and lives long, yet surely I know that it will be better with those who fear God, who are reverent before him.
13 But it shall not be well with the wicked, neither shall he lengthen days like a shadow, because he doesn't fear God.
14 There is a vanity which is done on the earth, that there are righteous men to whom it happens according to the work of the wicked. Again, there are wicked men to whom it happens according to the work of the righteous. I said that this also is vanity.
15 Then I commended mirth, because a man has no better thing under the sun than to eat, to drink, and to be joyful: for that will accompany him in his labor all the days of his life which God has given him under the sun.
16 When I applied my heart to know wisdom, and to see the business that is done on the earth (even though eyes see no sleep day or night),
17 then I saw all the work of God, that man can't find out the work that is done under the sun, because however much a man labors to seek it out, yet he won't find it. Yes even though a wise man thinks he can comprehend it, he won't be able to find it.

9

1 For all this I laid to my heart, even to explore all this: that the righteous, and the wise, and their works, are in the hand of God; whether it is love or hatred, man doesn't know it; all is before them.
2 All things come alike to all. There is one event to the righteous and to the wicked; to the good, to the clean, to the unclean, to him who sacrifices, and to him who doesn't sacrifice. As is the good, so is the sinner; he who takes an oath, as he who fears an oath.
3 This is an evil in all that is done under the sun, that there is one event to all. Yes also, the heart of the sons of men is full of evil, and madness is in their heart while

they live, and after that they go to the dead.
4 For to him who is joined with all the living there is hope; for a living dog is better than a dead lion.
5 For the living know that they will die, but the dead don't know anything, neither do they have any more a reward; for their memory is forgotten.
6 Also their love, their hatred, and their envy has perished long ago; neither do they any longer have a portion forever in anything that is done under the sun.
7 Go your way—eat your bread with joy, and drink your wine with a merry heart; for God has already accepted your works.
8 Let your garments be always white, and don't let your head lack oil.
9 Live joyfully with the wife whom you love all the days of your life of vanity, which he has given you under the sun, all your days of vanity, for that is your portion in life, and in your labor in which you labor under the sun.
10 Whatever your hand finds to do, do it with your might; for there is no work, nor plan, nor knowledge, nor wisdom, in Sheol,† where you are going.
11 I returned and saw under the sun that the race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, neither yet bread to the wise, nor yet riches to men of understanding, nor yet favor to men of skill; but time and chance happen to them all.
12 For man also doesn't know his time. As the fish that are taken in an evil net, and as the birds that are caught in the snare, even so are the sons of men snared in an evil time, when it falls suddenly on them.
13 I have also seen wisdom under the sun in this way, and it seemed great to me.
14 There was a little city, and few men within it; and a great king came against it, besieged it, and built great bulwarks against it.
15 Now a poor wise man was found in it, and he by his wisdom delivered the city; yet no man remembered that same poor man.
16 Then I said, "Wisdom is better than strength." Nevertheless the poor man's wisdom is despised, and his words are not heard.
17 The words of the wise heard in quiet are better than the cry of him who rules among fools.
18 Wisdom is better than weapons of war; but one sinner destroys much good.

10

1 Dead flies cause the oil of the perfumer
to produce an evil odor;
so does a little folly outweigh wisdom
and honor.
2 A wise man's heart is at his right hand,
but a fool's heart at his left.
3 Yes also when the fool walks by the way, his understanding fails him, and he says to everyone that he is a fool.
4 If the spirit of the ruler rises up against you, don't leave your place; for gentleness lays great offenses to rest.
5 There is an evil which I have seen under the sun, the sort of error which proceeds from the ruler.
6 Folly is set in great dignity, and the rich sit in a low place.
7 I have seen servants on horses, and princes walking like servants on the earth.
8 He who digs a pit may fall into it; and whoever breaks through a wall may be bitten by a snake.
9 Whoever carves out stones may be injured by them. Whoever splits wood may be endangered by it.
10 If the ax is blunt, and one doesn't sharpen the edge, then he must use more strength; but skill brings success.
11 If the snake bites before it is charmed, then is there no profit for the charmer's tongue.
12 The words of a wise man's mouth are gracious; but a fool is swallowed by his own lips.
13 The beginning of the words of his mouth is foolishness; and the end of his talk is mischievous madness.
14 A fool also multiplies words.

† **9:10** Sheol is the place of the dead.

Man doesn't know what will be; and
that which will be after him, who can tell
him?
15 The labor of fools wearies every one
of them; for he doesn't know how to go to
the city.
16 Woe to you, land, when your king is a
child,
and your princes eat in the morning!
17 Happy are you, land, when your king is
the son of nobles,
and your princes eat in due season,
for strength, and not for
drunkenness!
18 By slothfulness the roof sinks in;
and through idleness of the hands the
house leaks.
19 A feast is made for laughter,
and wine makes the life glad;
and money is the answer for all
things.
20 Don't curse the king, no, not in your
thoughts;
and don't curse the rich in your
bedroom,
for a bird of the sky may carry your
voice,
and that which has wings may tell the
matter.

11

1 Cast your bread on the waters;
for you shall find it after many days.
2 Give a portion to seven, yes, even to
eight;
for you don't know what evil will be
on the earth.
3 If the clouds are full of rain, they empty
themselves on the earth;
and if a tree falls toward the south, or
toward the north,
in the place where the tree falls, there
shall it be.
4 He who observes the wind won't sow;
and he who regards the clouds won't
reap.
5 As you don't know what is the way of the
wind,
nor how the bones grow in the womb
of her who is with child;
even so you don't know the work of
God who does all.
6 In the morning sow your seed,
and in the evening don't withhold
your hand;
for you don't know which will
prosper, whether this or that,
or whether they both will be equally
good.
7 Truly the light is sweet,
and it is a pleasant thing for the eyes
to see the sun.
8 Yes, if a man lives many years, let him
rejoice in them all;
but let him remember the days of
darkness, for they shall be many.
All that comes is vanity.
9 Rejoice, young man, in your youth,
and let your heart cheer you in the
days of your youth,
and walk in the ways of your heart,
and in the sight of your eyes;
but know that for all these things God
will bring you into judgment.
10 Therefore remove sorrow from your
heart,
and put away evil from your flesh;
for youth and the dawn of life are
vanity.

12

1 Remember also your Creator in the
days of your youth,
before the evil days come, and the
years draw near,
when you will say, "I have no
pleasure in them;"
2 Before the sun, the light, the moon, and
the stars are darkened,
and the clouds return after the rain;
3 in the day when the keepers of the house
shall tremble,
and the strong men shall bow
themselves,
and the grinders cease because they
are few,
and those who look out of the
windows are darkened,
4 and the doors shall be shut in the street;
when the sound of the grinding is low,
and one shall rise up at the voice of a
bird,
and all the daughters of music shall
be brought low;

5 yes, they shall be afraid of heights,
and terrors will be on the way;
and the almond tree shall blossom,
and the grasshopper shall be a burden,
and desire shall fail;
because man goes to his everlasting home,
and the mourners go about the streets;
6 before the silver cord is severed,
or the golden bowl is broken,
or the pitcher is broken at the spring,
or the wheel broken at the cistern,
7 and the dust returns to the earth as it was,
and the spirit returns to God who gave it.
8 "Vanity of vanities," says the Preacher.
"All is vanity!"

9 Further, because the Preacher was wise, he still taught the people knowledge. Yes, he pondered, sought out, and set in order many proverbs.

10 The Preacher sought to find out acceptable words, and that which was written blamelessly, words of truth.

11 The words of the wise are like goads; and like nails well fastened are words from the masters of assemblies, which are given from one shepherd.

12 Furthermore, my son, be admonished: of making many books there is no end; and much study is a weariness of the flesh.

13 This is the end of the matter. All has been heard. Fear God and keep his commandments; for this is the whole duty of man.

14 For God will bring every work into judgment, with every hidden thing, whether it is good, or whether it is evil.

The Song of Solomon

1 The Song of songs, which is Solomon's.
Beloved
2 Let him kiss me with the kisses of his mouth;
for your love is better than wine.
3 Your oils have a pleasing fragrance.
Your name is oil poured out,
therefore the virgins love you.
4 Take me away with you.
Let's hurry.
The king has brought me into his rooms.
Friends
We will be glad and rejoice in you.
We will praise your love more than wine!
Beloved
They are right to love you.
5 I am dark, but lovely,
you daughters of Jerusalem,
like Kedar's tents,
like Solomon's curtains.
6 Don't stare at me because I am dark,
because the sun has scorched me.
My mother's sons were angry with me.
They made me keeper of the vineyards.
I haven't kept my own vineyard.
7 Tell me, you whom my soul loves,
where you graze your flock,
where you rest them at noon;
for why should I be as one who is veiled
beside the flocks of your companions?
Lover
8 If you don't know, most beautiful among women,
follow the tracks of the sheep.
Graze your young goats beside the shepherds' tents.

9 I have compared you, my love,
to a steed in Pharaoh's chariots.
10 Your cheeks are beautiful with earrings,
your neck with strings of jewels.
Friends
11 We will make you earrings of gold,
with studs of silver.
Beloved
12 While the king sat at his table,
my perfume spread its fragrance.
13 My beloved is to me a sachet of myrrh,
that lies between my breasts.
14 My beloved is to me a cluster of henna blossoms
from the vineyards of En Gedi.
Lover
15 Behold,† you are beautiful, my love.
Behold, you are beautiful.
Your eyes are like doves.
Beloved
16 Behold, you are beautiful, my beloved,
yes, pleasant;
and our couch is verdant.
Lover
17 The beams of our house are cedars.
Our rafters are firs.

2

Beloved
1 I am a rose of Sharon,
a lily of the valleys.
Lover
2 As a lily among thorns,
so is my love among the daughters.
Beloved
3 As the apple tree among the trees of the wood,
so is my beloved among the sons.
I sat down under his shadow with great delight,
his fruit was sweet to my taste.
4 He brought me to the banquet hall.
His banner over me is love.
5 Strengthen me with raisins,
refresh me with apples;
for I am faint with love.
6 His left hand is under my head.
His right hand embraces me.
7 I adjure you, daughters of Jerusalem,
by the roes, or by the hinds of the field,
that you not stir up, nor awaken love,
until it so desires.

8 The voice of my beloved!
Behold, he comes,
leaping on the mountains,
skipping on the hills.

† **1:15** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

9 My beloved is like a roe or a young deer.
Behold, he stands behind our wall!
He looks in at the windows.
He glances through the lattice.

10 My beloved spoke, and said to me,
"Rise up, my love, my beautiful one,
and come away.
11 For behold, the winter is past.
The rain is over and gone.
12 The flowers appear on the earth.
The time of the singing has come,
and the voice of the turtledove is
heard in our land.
13 The fig tree ripens her green figs.
The vines are in blossom.
They give out their fragrance.
Arise, my love, my beautiful one,
and come away."
Lover
14 My dove in the clefts of the rock,
in the hiding places of the
mountainside,
let me see your face.
Let me hear your voice;
for your voice is sweet and your face
is lovely.
15 Catch for us the foxes,
the little foxes that plunder the
vineyards;
for our vineyards are in blossom.
Beloved
16 My beloved is mine, and I am his.
He browses among the lilies.
17 Until the day is cool, and the shadows
flee away,
turn, my beloved,
and be like a roe or a young deer on
the mountains of Bether.

3

1 By night on my bed,
I sought him whom my soul loves.
I sought him, but I didn't find him.
2 I will get up now, and go about the city;
in the streets and in the squares I will
seek him whom my soul loves.
I sought him, but I didn't find him.
3 The watchmen who go about the city
found me;
"Have you seen him whom my soul
loves?"
4 I had scarcely passed from them,
when I found him whom my soul
loves.
I held him, and would not let him go,
until I had brought him into my
mother's house,
into the room of her who conceived
me.

5 I adjure you, daughters of Jerusalem,
by the roes, or by the hinds of the
field,
that you not stir up nor awaken love,
until it so desires.

6 Who is this who comes up from the
wilderness like pillars of smoke,
perfumed with myrrh and
frankincense,
with all spices of the merchant?
7 Behold, it is Solomon's carriage!
Sixty mighty men are around it,
of the mighty men of Israel.
8 They all handle the sword, and are
expert in war.
Every man has his sword on his thigh,
because of fear in the night.

9 King Solomon made himself a carriage
of the wood of Lebanon.
10 He made its pillars of silver,
its bottom of gold, its seat of purple,
the middle of it being paved with love,
from the daughters of Jerusalem.
11 Go out, you daughters of Zion, and see
King Solomon,
with the crown with which his
mother has crowned him,
in the day of his weddings,
in the day of the gladness of his heart.

4

Lover
1 Behold, you are beautiful, my love.
Behold, you are beautiful.
Your eyes are like doves behind your veil.
Your hair is as a flock of goats,
that descend from Mount Gilead.
2 Your teeth are like a newly shorn flock,
which have come up from the
washing,
where every one of them has twins.
None is bereaved among them.

3 Your lips are like scarlet thread.
Your mouth is lovely.
Your temples are like a piece of a
pomegranate behind your veil.
4 Your neck is like David's tower built for
an armory,
on which a thousand shields hang,
all the shields of the mighty men.
5 Your two breasts are like two fawns
that are twins of a roe,
which feed among the lilies.

6 Until the day is cool, and the shadows
flee away,
I will go to the mountain of myrrh,
to the hill of frankincense.

7 You are all beautiful, my love.
There is no spot in you.
8 Come with me from Lebanon, my bride,
with me from Lebanon.
Look from the top of Amana,
from the top of Senir and Hermon,
from the lions' dens,
from the mountains of the leopards.

9 You have ravished my heart, my sister,
my bride.
You have ravished my heart with one
of your eyes,
with one chain of your neck.
10 How beautiful is your love, my sister,
my bride!
How much better is your love than
wine,
the fragrance of your perfumes than
all kinds of spices!
11 Your lips, my bride, drip like the
honeycomb.
Honey and milk are under your
tongue.
The smell of your garments is like the
smell of Lebanon.
12 My sister, my bride, is a locked up
garden;
a locked up spring,
a sealed fountain.
13 Your shoots are an orchard of
pomegranates, with precious fruits,
henna with spikenard plants,
14 spikenard and saffron,
calamus and cinnamon, with every
kind of incense tree;
myrrh and aloes, with all the best
spices,
15 a fountain of gardens,
a well of living waters,
flowing streams from Lebanon.
Beloved
16 Awake, north wind, and come, you
south!
Blow on my garden, that its spices
may flow out.
Let my beloved come into his garden,
and taste his precious fruits.

5

Lover
1 I have come into my garden, my sister,
my bride.
I have gathered my myrrh with my
spice;
I have eaten my honeycomb with my
honey;
I have drunk my wine with my milk.
Friends
Eat, friends!
Drink, yes, drink abundantly,
beloved.
Beloved
2 I was asleep, but my heart was awake.
It is the voice of my beloved who
knocks:
"Open to me, my sister, my love, my
dove, my undefiled;
for my head is filled with dew,
and my hair with the dampness of the
night."
3 I have taken off my robe. Indeed, must I
put it on?
I have washed my feet. Indeed, must I
soil them?
4 My beloved thrust his hand in through
the latch opening.
My heart pounded for him.
5 I rose up to open for my beloved.
My hands dripped with myrrh,
my fingers with liquid myrrh,
on the handles of the lock.
6 I opened to my beloved;
but my beloved left, and had gone
away.
My heart went out when he spoke.

I looked for him, but I didn't find him.
I called him, but he didn't answer.
7 The watchmen who go about the city
found me.
They beat me.
They bruised me.
The keepers of the walls took my
cloak away from me.

8 I adjure you, daughters of Jerusalem,
If you find my beloved,
that you tell him that I am faint with
love.
Friends
9 How is your beloved better than another
beloved,
you fairest among women?
How is your beloved better than another
beloved,
that you do so adjure us?
Beloved
10 My beloved is white and ruddy.
The best among ten thousand.
11 His head is like the purest gold.
His hair is bushy, black as a raven.
12 His eyes are like doves beside the water
brooks,
washed with milk, mounted like
jewels.
13 His cheeks are like a bed of spices with
towers of perfumes.
His lips are like lilies, dropping liquid
myrrh.
14 His hands are like rings of gold set with
beryl.
His body is like ivory work overlaid
with sapphires.
15 His legs are like pillars of marble set on
sockets of fine gold.
His appearance is like Lebanon,
excellent as the cedars.
16 His mouth is sweetness;
yes, he is altogether lovely.
This is my beloved, and this is my friend,
daughters of Jerusalem.

6

Friends
1 Where has your beloved gone, you
fairest among women?
Where has your beloved turned, that
we may seek him with you?
Beloved
2 My beloved has gone down to his garden,
to the beds of spices,
to pasture his flock in the gardens,
and to gather lilies.
3 I am my beloved's, and my beloved is
mine.
He browses among the lilies.

Lover
4 You are beautiful, my love, as Tirzah,
lovely as Jerusalem,
awesome as an army with banners.
5 Turn away your eyes from me,
for they have overcome me.
Your hair is like a flock of goats,
that lie along the side of Gilead.
6 Your teeth are like a flock of ewes,
which have come up from the
washing,
of which every one has twins;
not one is bereaved among them.
7 Your temples are like a piece of a
pomegranate behind your veil.

8 There are sixty queens, eighty
concubines,
and virgins without number.
9 My dove, my perfect one, is unique.
She is her mother's only daughter.
She is the favorite one of her who
bore her.
The daughters saw her, and called her
blessed.
The queens and the concubines saw
her, and they praised her.

10 Who is she who looks out as the
morning,
beautiful as the moon,
clear as the sun,
and awesome as an army with
banners?

11 I went down into the nut tree grove,
to see the green plants of the valley,
to see whether the vine budded,
and the pomegranates were in flower.
12 Without realizing it,

my desire set me with my royal
people's chariots.
Friends
13 Return, return, Shulammite!
Return, return, that we may gaze at
you.
Lover
Why do you desire to gaze at the
Shulammite,
as at the dance of Mahanaim?

7

1 How beautiful are your feet in sandals,
prince's daughter!
Your rounded thighs are like jewels,
the work of the hands of a skillful
workman.
2 Your body is like a round goblet,
no mixed wine is wanting.
Your waist is like a heap of wheat,
set about with lilies.
3 Your two breasts are like two fawns,
that are twins of a roe.
4 Your neck is like an ivory tower.
Your eyes are like the pools in
Heshbon by the gate of Bathrabbim.
Your nose is like the tower of Lebanon
which looks toward Damascus.
5 Your head on you is like Carmel.
The hair of your head like purple.
The king is held captive in its tresses.
6 How beautiful and how pleasant you are,
love, for delights!
7 This, your stature, is like a palm tree,
your breasts like its fruit.
8 I said, "I will climb up into the palm tree.
I will take hold of its fruit."
Let your breasts be like clusters of the
vine,
the smell of your breath like apples.
9 Your mouth is like the best wine,
that goes down smoothly for my
beloved,
gliding through the lips of those who
are asleep.
Beloved
10 I am my beloved's.
His desire is toward me.
11 Come, my beloved! Let's go out into the
field.
Let's lodge in the villages.
12 Let's go early up to the vineyards.
Let's see whether the vine has
budded,
its blossom is open,
and the pomegranates are in flower.
There I will give you my love.
13 The mandrakes produce fragrance.
At our doors are all kinds of precious
fruits, new and old,
which I have stored up for you, my
beloved.

8

1 Oh that you were like my brother,
who nursed from the breasts of my
mother!
If I found you outside, I would kiss you;
yes, and no one would despise me.
2 I would lead you, bringing you into the
house of my mother,
who would instruct me.
I would have you drink spiced wine,
of the juice of my pomegranate.
3 His left hand would be under my head.
His right hand would embrace me.

4 I adjure you, daughters of Jerusalem,
that you not stir up, nor awaken love,
until it so desires.
Friends
5 Who is this who comes up from the
wilderness,
leaning on her beloved?

Beloved
Under the apple tree I awakened you.
There your mother conceived you.
There she was in labor and bore you.

6 Set me as a seal on your heart,
as a seal on your arm;
for love is strong as death.
Jealousy is as cruel as Sheol.†
Its flashes are flashes of fire,
a very flame of Yah.‡
7 Many waters can't quench love,
neither can floods drown it.
If a man would give all the wealth of his
house for love,
he would be utterly scorned.
Brothers

† **8:6** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **8:6** "Yah" is a short form of "Yahweh", which is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations.

8 We have a little sister.
She has no breasts.
What shall we do for our sister
in the day when she is to be spoken
for?

9 If she is a wall,
we will build on her a turret of silver.
If she is a door,
we will enclose her with boards of
cedar.
Beloved
10 I am a wall, and my breasts like towers,
then I was in his eyes like one who
found peace.
11 Solomon had a vineyard at Baal Hamon.
He leased out the vineyard to keepers.
Each was to bring a thousand
shekels§ of silver for its fruit.
12 My own vineyard is before me.
The thousand are for you, Solomon,
two hundred for those who tend its
fruit.
Lover
13 You who dwell in the gardens, with
friends in attendance,
let me hear your voice!
Beloved
14 Come away, my beloved!
Be like a gazelle or a young stag on
the mountains of spices!

§ **8:11** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1000 shekels is about 10 kilograms or about 22 pounds.

The Book of the Prophet Isaiah

1 The vision of Isaiah the son of Amoz,
which he saw concerning Judah and
Jerusalem, in the days of Uzziah, Jotham,
Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah.
2 Hear, heavens,
and listen, earth; for Yahweh† has
spoken:
"I have nourished and brought up
children
and they have rebelled against me.
3 The ox knows his owner,
and the donkey his master's crib;
but Israel doesn't know.
My people don't consider."
4 Ah sinful nation,
a people loaded with iniquity,
offspring‡ of evildoers,
children who deal corruptly!
They have forsaken Yahweh.
They have despised the Holy One of
Israel.
They are estranged and backward.
5 Why should you be beaten more,
that you revolt more and more?
The whole head is sick,
and the whole heart faint.
6 From the sole of the foot even to the head
there is no soundness in it,
but wounds, welts, and open sores.
They haven't been closed, bandaged,
or soothed with oil.
7 Your country is desolate.
Your cities are burned with fire.
Strangers devour your land in your
presence
and it is desolate,
as overthrown by strangers.
8 The daughter of Zion is left like a shelter
in a vineyard,
like a hut in a field of melons,
like a besieged city.
9 Unless Yahweh of Armies had left to us a
very small remnant,
we would have been as Sodom.
We would have been like Gomorrah.
10 Hear Yahweh's word, you rulers of
Sodom!
Listen to the law of our God,§ you
people of Gomorrah!
11 "What are the multitude of your
sacrifices to me?", says Yahweh.
"I have had enough of the burnt
offerings of rams
and the fat of fed animals.
I don't delight in the blood of bulls,
or of lambs,
or of male goats.
12 When you come to appear before me,
who has required this at your hand,
to trample my courts?
13 Bring no more vain offerings.
Incense is an abomination to me.
New moons, Sabbaths, and
convocations—
I can't stand evil assemblies.
14 My soul hates your New Moons and
your appointed feasts.
They are a burden to me.
I am weary of bearing them.
15 When you spread out your hands, I will
hide my eyes from you.
Yes, when you make many prayers, I
will not hear.
Your hands are full of blood.
16 Wash yourselves. Make yourself clean.
Put away the evil of your doings from
before my eyes.
Cease to do evil.
17 Learn to do well.
Seek justice.
Relieve the oppressed.
Defend the fatherless.
Plead for the widow."

18 "Come now, and let's reason together,"
says Yahweh:
"Though your sins are as scarlet, they
shall be as white as snow.
Though they are red like crimson,
they shall be as wool.
19 If you are willing and obedient,
you will eat the good of the land;
20 but if you refuse and rebel, you will
be devoured with the sword;
for Yahweh's mouth has spoken it."

† **1:2** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:4** or, seed
§ **1:10** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

21 How the faithful city has become a
prostitute!
She was full of justice.
Righteousness lodged in her,
but now there are murderers.
22 Your silver has become dross,
your wine mixed with water.
23 Your princes are rebellious and
companions of thieves.
Everyone loves bribes and follows
after rewards.
They don't defend the fatherless,
neither does the cause of the widow
come to them.

24 Therefore the Lord,† Yahweh of Armies,
the Mighty One of Israel, says:
"Ah, I will get relief from my adversaries,
and avenge myself on my enemies.
25 I will turn my hand on you,
thoroughly purge away your dross,
and will take away all your tin.‡
26 I will restore your judges as at the first,
and your counselors as at the
beginning.
Afterward you shall be called 'The city of
righteousness,
a faithful town.'
27 Zion shall be redeemed with justice,
and her converts with righteousness.
28 But the destruction of transgressors and
sinners shall be together,
and those who forsake Yahweh shall
be consumed.
29 For they shall be ashamed of the oaks
which you have desired,
and you shall be confounded for the
gardens that you have chosen.
30 For you shall be as an oak whose leaf
fades,
and as a garden that has no water.
31 The strong will be like tinder,
and his work like a spark.
They will both burn together,
and no one will quench them."

2

1 This is what Isaiah the son of Amoz
saw concerning Judah and Jerusalem.
2 It shall happen in the latter days, that the
mountain of Yahweh's house shall
be established on the top of the
mountains,
and shall be raised above the hills;
and all nations shall flow to it.
3 Many peoples shall go and say,
"Come, let's go up to the mountain of
Yahweh,
to the house of the God of Jacob;
and he will teach us of his ways,
and we will walk in his paths."
For the law shall go out of Zion,
and Yahweh's word from Jerusalem.
4 He will judge between the nations,
and will decide concerning many
peoples.
They shall beat their swords into
plowshares,
and their spears into pruning hooks.
Nation shall not lift up sword against
nation,
neither shall they learn war any
more.

5 House of Jacob, come, and let's walk in
the light of Yahweh.
6 For you have forsaken your people, the
house of Jacob,
because they are filled from the east,
with those who practice divination
like the Philistines,
and they clasp hands with the
children of foreigners.
7 Their land is full of silver and gold,
neither is there any end of their
treasures.
Their land also is full of horses,
neither is there any end of their
chariots.
8 Their land also is full of idols.
They worship the work of their own
hands,
that which their own fingers have
made.
9 Man is brought low,
and mankind is humbled;
therefore don't forgive them.
10 Enter into the rock,
and hide in the dust,
from before the terror of Yahweh,

† **1:24** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." ‡ **1:25** tin is a metal that is separated from silver during the refining and purification process.

and from the glory of his majesty.
11 The lofty looks of man will be brought
low,
the arrogance of men will be bowed
down,
and Yahweh alone will be exalted in
that day.

12 For there will be a day of Yahweh of
Armies for all that is proud and
arrogant,
and for all that is lifted up,
and it shall be brought low—
13 for all the cedars of Lebanon, that
are high and lifted up,
for all the oaks of Bashan,
14 for all the high mountains,
for all the hills that are lifted up,
15 for every lofty tower,
for every fortified wall,
16 for all the ships of Tarshish,
and for all pleasant imagery.
17 The loftiness of man shall be bowed
down,
and the arrogance of men shall be
brought low;
and Yahweh alone shall be exalted in
that day.
18 The idols shall utterly pass away.
19 Men shall go into the caves of the rocks,
and into the holes of the earth,
from before the terror of Yahweh,
and from the glory of his majesty,
when he arises to shake the earth
mightily.
20 In that day, men shall cast away their
idols of silver
and their idols of gold,
which have been made for
themselves to worship,
to the moles and to the bats,
21 to go into the caverns of the rocks,
and into the clefts of the ragged rocks,
from before the terror of Yahweh,
and from the glory of his majesty,
when he arises to shake the earth
mightily.
22 Stop trusting in man, whose breath is in
his nostrils;
for of what account is he?

3

1 For, behold,† the Lord, Yahweh of Armies,
takes away from Jerusalem and
from Judah supply and support,
the whole supply of bread,
and the whole supply of water;
2 the mighty man,
the man of war,
the judge,
the prophet,
the diviner,
the elder,
3 the captain of fifty,
the honorable man,
the counselor,
the skilled craftsman,
and the clever enchanter.
4 I will give boys to be their princes,
and children shall rule over them.
5 The people will be oppressed,
everyone by another,
and everyone by his neighbor.
The child will behave himself proudly
against the old man,
and the wicked against the honorable.
6 Indeed a man shall take hold of his
brother in the house of his father,
saying,
“You have clothing, you be our ruler,
and let this ruin be under your hand.”
7 In that day he will cry out, saying, “I will
not be a healer;
for in my house is neither bread nor
clothing.
You shall not make me ruler of the
people.”
8 For Jerusalem is ruined, and Judah is
fallen;
because their tongue and their doings
are against Yahweh,
to provoke the eyes of his glory.
9 The look of their faces testify against
them.
They parade their sin like Sodom.
They don’t hide it.
Woe to their soul!
For they have brought disaster upon
themselves.
10 Tell the righteous that it will be well
with them,

† **3:1** “Behold”, from “הִנֵּה”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

for they will eat the fruit of their
deeds.
11 Woe to the wicked!
Disaster is upon them,
for the deeds of their hands will be
paid back to them.
12 As for my people, children are their
oppressors,
and women rule over them.
My people, those who lead you cause
you to err,
and destroy the way of your paths.

13 Yahweh stands up to contend,
and stands to judge the peoples.
14 Yahweh will enter into judgment with
the elders of his people
and their leaders:
"It is you who have eaten up the
vineyard.
The plunder of the poor is in your
houses.
15 What do you mean that you crush
my people,
and grind the face of the poor?" says
the Lord, Yahweh of Armies.

16 Moreover Yahweh said, "Because the
daughters of Zion are arrogant,
and walk with outstretched necks
and flirting eyes,
walking daintily as they go,
jingling ornaments on their feet;
17 therefore the Lord brings sores on the
crown of the head of the women of
Zion,
and Yahweh will make their scalps
bald."
18 In that day the Lord will take away
the beauty of their anklets, the
headbands, the crescent necklaces,
19 the earrings, the bracelets, the veils,
20 the headdresses, the ankle chains, the
sashes, the perfume containers, the
charms,
21 the signet rings, the nose rings,
22 the fine robes, the capes, the cloaks,
the purses,
23 the hand mirrors, the fine linen
garments, the tiaras, and the shawls.
24 It shall happen that instead of sweet
spices, there shall be rottenness;
instead of a belt, a rope;
instead of well set hair, baldness;
instead of a robe, a wearing of
sackcloth;
and branding instead of beauty.
25 Your men shall fall by the sword,
and your mighty in the war.
26 Her gates shall lament and mourn.
She shall be desolate and sit on the
ground.

4

1 Seven women shall take hold of one
man in that day, saying, "We will eat our
own bread, and wear our own clothing.
Just let us be called by your name. Take
away our reproach."
2 In that day, Yahweh's branch will be
beautiful and glorious, and the fruit of the
land will be the beauty and glory of the
survivors of Israel.
3 It will happen that he who is left in
Zion and he who remains in Jerusalem
shall be called holy, even everyone who is
written among the living in Jerusalem,
4 when the Lord shall have washed
away the filth of the daughters of Zion,
and shall have purged the blood of
Jerusalem from within it, by the spirit of
justice and by the spirit of burning.
5 Yahweh will create over the whole
habitation of Mount Zion and over her
assemblies, a cloud and smoke by day,
and the shining of a flaming fire by night,
for over all the glory will be a canopy.
6 There will be a pavilion for a shade in
the daytime from the heat, and for a
refuge and for a shelter from storm and
from rain.

5

1 Let me sing for my well beloved a song of
my beloved about his vineyard.
My beloved had a vineyard on a very
fruitful hill.
2 He dug it up,
gathered out its stones,
planted it with the choicest vine,
built a tower in the middle of it,
and also cut out a wine press in it.
He looked for it to yield grapes,
but it yielded wild grapes.

3 “Now, inhabitants of Jerusalem and men
of Judah,
please judge between me and my
vineyard.
4 What could have been done more to my
vineyard, that I have not done in it?
Why, when I looked for it to yield
grapes, did it yield wild grapes?
5 Now I will tell you what I will do to my
vineyard.
I will take away its hedge, and it will
be eaten up.
I will break down its wall, and it will
be trampled down.
6 I will lay it a wasteland.
It won’t be pruned or hoed,
but it will grow briers and thorns.
I will also command the clouds that
they rain no rain on it.”
7 For the vineyard of Yahweh of Armies is
the house of Israel,
and the men of Judah his pleasant
plant.
He looked for justice, but behold,
oppression,
for righteousness, but behold, a cry of
distress.

8 Woe to those who join house to house,
who lay field to field, until there is no
room,
and you are made to dwell alone in
the middle of the land!
9 In my ears, Yahweh of Armies says:
“Surely many houses will be
desolate,
even great and beautiful, unoccupied.
10 For ten acres† of vineyard shall yield
one bath,‡
and a homer§ of seed shall yield an
ephah.”†
11 Woe to those who rise up early in the
morning, that they may follow
strong drink,
who stay late into the night, until
wine inflames them!
12 The harp, lyre, tambourine, and flute,
with wine, are at their feasts;
but they don’t respect the work of
Yahweh,
neither have they considered the
operation of his hands.

13 Therefore my people go into captivity
for lack of knowledge.
Their honorable men are famished,
and their multitudes are parched
with thirst.
14 Therefore Sheol‡ has enlarged its desire,
and opened its mouth without
measure;
and their glory, their multitude, their
pomp, and he who rejoices among
them, descend into it.
15 So man is brought low,
mankind is humbled,
and the eyes of the arrogant ones are
humbled;
16 but Yahweh of Armies is exalted in
justice,
and God the Holy One is sanctified in
righteousness.
17 Then the lambs will graze as in their
pasture,
and strangers will eat the ruins of the
rich.

18 Woe to those who draw iniquity with
cords of falsehood,
and wickedness as with cart rope,
19 who say, “Let him make haste, let him
hasten his work, that we may see it;
let the counsel of the Holy One of
Israel draw near and come,
that we may know it!”
20 Woe to those who call evil good, and
good evil;
who put darkness for light,
and light for darkness;
who put bitter for sweet,
and sweet for bitter!
21 Woe to those who are wise in their own
eyes,
and prudent in their own sight!
22 Woe to those who are mighty to drink
wine,

† **5:10** literally, ten yokes, or the amount of land that ten yokes of oxen can plow in one day, which is about 10 acres or 4 hectares. ‡ **5:10** 1 bath is about 22 liters or 5.8 U. S. gallons § **5:10** 1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels † **5:10** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or 0.6 bushels or about 2 pecks—only one tenth of what was sown. ‡ **5:14** Sheol is the place of the dead.

and champions at mixing strong
drink;
23 who acquit the guilty for a bribe,
but deny justice for the innocent!

24 Therefore as the tongue of fire devours
the stubble,
and as the dry grass sinks down in the
flame,
so their root shall be as rottenness,
and their blossom shall go up as dust,
because they have rejected the law of
Yahweh of Armies,
and despised the word of the Holy
One of Israel.
25 Therefore Yahweh's anger burns
against his people,
and he has stretched out his hand
against them and has struck them.
The mountains tremble,
and their dead bodies are as refuse in
the middle of the streets.
For all this, his anger is not turned away,
but his hand is still stretched out.

26 He will lift up a banner to the nations
from far away,
and he will whistle for them from the
end of the earth.
Behold, they will come speedily and
swiftly.
27 No one shall be weary nor stumble
among them;
no one shall slumber nor sleep,
neither shall the belt of their waist be
untied,
nor the strap of their sandals be
broken,
28 whose arrows are sharp,
and all their bows bent.
Their horses' hoofs will be like flint,
and their wheels like a whirlwind.
29 Their roaring will be like a lioness.
They will roar like young lions.
Yes, they shall roar,
and seize their prey and carry it off,
and there will be no one to deliver.
30 They will roar against them in that day
like the roaring of the sea.
If one looks to the land, behold,
darkness and distress.
The light is darkened in its clouds.

6

1 In the year that King Uzziah died, I saw
the Lord sitting on a throne, high and
lifted up; and his train filled the temple.
2 Above him stood the seraphim. Each
one had six wings. With two he covered
his face. With two he covered his feet.
With two he flew.
3 One called to another, and said,
"Holy, holy, holy, is Yahweh of Armies!
The whole earth is full of his glory!"
4 The foundations of the thresholds
shook at the voice of him who called, and
the house was filled with smoke.
5 Then I said, "Woe is me! For I am
undone, because I am a man of unclean
lips and I live among a people of unclean
lips, for my eyes have seen the King,
Yahweh of Armies!"
6 Then one of the seraphim flew to me,
having a live coal in his hand, which he
had taken with the tongs from off the
altar.
7 He touched my mouth with it, and
said, "Behold, this has touched your lips;
and your iniquity is taken away, and your
sin forgiven."
8 I heard the Lord's voice, saying,
"Whom shall I send, and who will go for
us?"
Then I said, "Here I am. Send me!"
9 He said, "Go, and tell this people,
'You hear indeed,
but don't understand.
You see indeed,
but don't perceive.'
10 Make the heart of this people fat.
Make their ears heavy, and shut their
eyes;
lest they see with their eyes,
hear with their ears,
understand with their heart,
and turn again, and be healed."
11 Then I said, "Lord, how long?"
He answered,
"Until cities are waste without inhabitant,
houses without man,
the land becomes utterly waste,
12 and Yahweh has removed men far
away,
and the forsaken places are many
within the land.
13 If there is a tenth left in it,

that also will in turn be consumed,
as a terebinth, and as an oak whose stump
remains when they are cut down,
so the holy seed is its stump."

7

1 In the days of Ahaz the son of Jotham,
the son of Uzziah, king of Judah, Rezin the
king of Syria and Pekah the son of
Remaliah, king of Israel, went up to
Jerusalem to war against it, but could not
prevail against it.
2 David's house was told, "Syria is allied
with Ephraim." His heart trembled, and
the heart of his people, as the trees of the
forest tremble with the wind.
3 Then Yahweh said to Isaiah, "Go out
now to meet Ahaz, you, and Shearjashub
your son, at the end of the conduit of the
upper pool, on the highway of the fuller's
field.
4 Tell him, 'Be careful, and keep calm.
Don't be afraid, neither let your heart be
faint because of these two tails of smoking
torches, for the fierce anger of Rezin and
Syria, and of the son of Remaliah.
5 Because Syria, Ephraim, and the son of
Remaliah, have plotted evil against you,
saying,
6 "Let's go up against Judah, and tear it
apart, and let's divide it among ourselves,
and set up a king within it, even the son of
Tabeel."
7 This is what the Lord Yahweh says: "It
shall not stand, neither shall it happen."
8 For the head of Syria is Damascus, and
the head of Damascus is Rezin. Within
sixty-five years Ephraim shall be broken
in pieces, so that it shall not be a people.
9 The head of Ephraim is Samaria, and
the head of Samaria is Remaliah's son. If
you will not believe, surely you shall not
be established.' "
10 Yahweh spoke again to Ahaz, saying,
11 "Ask a sign of Yahweh your God; ask it
either in the depth, or in the height
above."
12 But Ahaz said, "I won't ask. I won't
tempt Yahweh."
13 He said, "Listen now, house of David.
Is it not enough for you to try the patience
of men, that you will try the patience of
my God also?
14 Therefore the Lord himself will give
you a sign. Behold, the virgin will
conceive, and bear a son, and shall call his
name Immanuel.†
15 He shall eat butter and honey when
he knows to refuse the evil and choose the
good.
16 For before the child knows to refuse
the evil and choose the good, the land
whose two kings you abhor shall be
forsaken.
17 Yahweh will bring on you, on your
people, and on your father's house days
that have not come, from the day that
Ephraim departed from Judah, even the
king of Assyria.
18 It will happen in that day that Yahweh
will whistle for the fly that is in the
uttermost part of the rivers of Egypt, and
for the bee that is in the land of Assyria.
19 They shall come, and shall all rest in
the desolate valleys, in the clefts of the
rocks, on all thorn hedges, and on all
pastures.
20 In that day the Lord will shave with a
razor that is hired in the parts beyond the
River, even with the king of Assyria, the
head and the hair of the feet; and it shall
also consume the beard.
21 It shall happen in that day that a man
shall keep alive a young cow, and two
sheep.
22 It shall happen, that because of the
abundance of milk which they shall give
he shall eat butter, for everyone will eat
butter and honey that is left within the
land.
23 It will happen in that day that every
place where there were a thousand vines
worth a thousand silver shekels,‡ will be
for briers and thorns.
24 People will go there with arrows and
with bow, because all the land will be
briers and thorns.
25 All the hills that were cultivated with
the hoe, you shall not come there for fear

† **7:14** "Immanuel" means "God with us". ‡ **7:23** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, so 1000 shekels is about 10 kilograms or 22 pounds.

of briers and thorns; but it shall be for the
sending out of oxen, and for sheep to
tread on."

8

1 Yahweh said to me, "Take a large
tablet, and write on it with a man's pen,
'For Maher Shalal Hash Baz';†
2 and I will take for myself faithful
witnesses to testify: Uriah the priest, and
Zechariah the son of Jeberechiah."

3 I went to the prophetess, and she
conceived, and bore a son. Then Yahweh
said to me, "Call his name 'Maher Shalal
Hash Baz.'
4 For before the child knows how to say,
'My father' and 'My mother,' the riches of
Damascus and the plunder of Samaria
will be carried away by the king of
Assyria."

5 Yahweh spoke to me yet again, saying,
6 "Because this people has refused the
waters of Shiloah that go softly, and
rejoice in Rezin and Remaliah's son;
7 now therefore, behold, the Lord brings
upon them the mighty flood waters of the
River: the king of Assyria and all his glory.
It will come up over all its channels, and
go over all its banks.
8 It will sweep onward into Judah. It will
overflow and pass through. It will reach
even to the neck. The stretching out of its
wings will fill the width of your land, O
Immanuel.
9 Make an uproar, you peoples, and be
broken in pieces! Listen, all you from far
countries: dress for battle, and be
shattered! Dress for battle, and be
shattered!
10 Take counsel together, and it will be
brought to nothing; speak the word, and it
will not stand, for God is with us."

11 For Yahweh spoke this to me with a
strong hand, and instructed me not to
walk in the way of this people, saying,
12 "Don't call a conspiracy all that this
people call a conspiracy. Don't fear their
threats or be terrorized.
13 Yahweh of Armies is who you must
respect as holy. He is the one you must
fear. He is the one you must dread.
14 He will be a sanctuary, but for both
houses of Israel, he will be a stumbling
stone and a rock that makes them fall. For
the people of Jerusalem, he will be a trap
and a snare.
15 Many will stumble over it, fall, be
broken, be snared, and be captured."
16 Wrap up the covenant. Seal the law
among my disciples.
17 I will wait for Yahweh, who hides his
face from the house of Jacob, and I will
look for him.
18 Behold, I and the children whom
Yahweh has given me are for signs and for
wonders in Israel from Yahweh of Armies,
who dwells in Mount Zion.
19 When they tell you, "Consult with
those who have familiar spirits and with
the wizards, who chirp and who mutter,"
shouldn't a people consult with their God?
Should they consult the dead on behalf of
the living?
20 Turn to the law and to the covenant!
If they don't speak according to this word,
surely there is no morning for them.
21 They will pass through it, very
distressed and hungry. It will happen that
when they are hungry, they will worry,
and curse their king and their God. They
will turn their faces upward,
22 then look to the earth and see distress,
darkness, and the gloom of anguish. They
will be driven into thick darkness.

9

1 But there shall be no more gloom for
her who was in anguish. In the former
time, he brought into contempt the land of
Zebulun and the land of Naphtali; but in
the latter time he has made it glorious, by
the way of the sea, beyond the Jordan,
Galilee of the nations.
2 The people who walked in darkness
have seen a great light.
The light has shined on those who
lived in the land of the shadow of
death.
3 You have multiplied the nation.

† **8:1** "Maher Shalal Hash Baz" means "quick to the plunder, swift to the prey".

You have increased their joy.
They rejoice before you according to the joy in harvest, as men rejoice when they divide the plunder.
4 For the yoke of his burden, and the staff of his shoulder, the rod of his oppressor, you have broken as in the day of Midian.
5 For all the armor of the armed man in the noisy battle, and the garments rolled in blood, will be for burning, fuel for the fire.
6 For a child is born to us. A son is given to us; and the government will be on his shoulders. His name will be called Wonderful Counselor, Mighty God, Everlasting Father, Prince of Peace.
7 Of the increase of his government and of peace there shall be no end, on David's throne, and on his kingdom, to establish it, and to uphold it with justice and with righteousness from that time on, even forever. The zeal of Yahweh of Armies will perform this.
8 The Lord sent a word into Jacob,
and it falls on Israel.
9 All the people will know,
including Ephraim and the inhabitants of Samaria, who say in pride and in arrogance of heart,
10 "The bricks have fallen,
but we will build with cut stone.
The sycamore fig trees have been cut down,
but we will put cedars in their place."
11 Therefore Yahweh will set up on high against him the adversaries of Rezin,
and will stir up his enemies,
12 The Syrians in front,
and the Philistines behind;
and they will devour Israel with open mouth.
For all this, his anger is not turned away,
but his hand is stretched out still.

13 Yet the people have not turned to him who struck them,
neither have they sought Yahweh of Armies.
14 Therefore Yahweh will cut off from Israel head and tail,
palm branch and reed, in one day.
15 The elder and the honorable man is the head,
and the prophet who teaches lies is the tail.
16 For those who lead this people lead them astray;
and those who are led by them are destroyed.
17 Therefore the Lord will not rejoice over their young men,
neither will he have compassion on their fatherless and widows;
for everyone is profane and an evildoer,
and every mouth speaks folly.
For all this his anger is not turned away,
but his hand is stretched out still.

18 For wickedness burns like a fire.
It devours the briers and thorns;
yes, it kindles in the thickets of the forest,
and they roll upward in a column of smoke.
19 Through Yahweh of Armies' wrath, the land is burned up;
and the people are the fuel for the fire.
No one spares his brother.
20 One will devour on the right hand, and be hungry;
and he will eat on the left hand, and they will not be satisfied.
Everyone will eat the flesh of his own arm:
21 Manasseh eating Ephraim and Ephraim eating Manasseh, and they together will be against Judah.
For all this his anger is not turned away,
but his hand is stretched out still.

10

1 Woe to those who decree unrighteous decrees, and to the writers who write oppressive decrees
2 to deprive the needy of justice, and to rob the poor among my people of their rights, that widows may be their plunder, and that they may make the fatherless their prey!
3 What will you do in the day of visitation, and in the desolation which will come from afar? To whom will you

flee for help? Where will you leave your
wealth?
4 They will only bow down under the
prisoners,
and will fall under the slain.
For all this his anger is not turned away,
but his hand is stretched out still.

5 Alas Assyrian, the rod of my anger, the
staff in whose hand is my indignation!
6 I will send him against a profane
nation, and against the people who anger
me I will give him a command to take the
plunder and to take the prey, and to tread
them down like the mire of the streets.
7 However, he doesn't mean so, neither
does his heart think so; but it is in his
heart to destroy, and to cut off not a few
nations.
8 For he says, "Aren't all of my princes
kings?
9 Isn't Calno like Carchemish? Isn't
Hamath like Arpad? Isn't Samaria like
Damascus?"
10 As my hand has found the kingdoms
of the idols, whose engraved images
exceeded those of Jerusalem and of
Samaria,
11 shall I not, as I have done to Samaria
and her idols, so do to Jerusalem and her
idols?
12 Therefore it will happen that when
the Lord has performed his whole work
on Mount Zion and on Jerusalem, I will
punish the fruit of the willful proud heart
of the king of Assyria, and the insolence of
his arrogant looks.
13 For he has said, "By the strength of my
hand I have done it, and by my wisdom,
for I have understanding. I have removed
the boundaries of the peoples, and have
robbed their treasures. Like a valiant
man I have brought down their rulers.
14 My hand has found the riches of the
peoples like a nest, and like one gathers
eggs that are abandoned, I have gathered
all the earth. There was no one who
moved their wing, or that opened their
mouth, or chirped."
15 Should an ax brag against him who
chops with it? Should a saw exalt itself
above him who saws with it? As if a rod
should lift those who lift it up, or as if a
staff should lift up someone who is not
wood.
16 Therefore the Lord, Yahweh of
Armies, will send among his fat ones
leanness; and under his glory a burning
will be kindled like the burning of fire.
17 The light of Israel will be for a fire,
and his Holy One for a flame; and it will
burn and devour his thorns and his briers
in one day.
18 He will consume the glory of his
forest and of his fruitful field, both soul
and body. It will be as when a standard
bearer faints.
19 The remnant of the trees of his forest
shall be few, so that a child could write
their number.
20 It will come to pass in that day that
the remnant of Israel, and those who have
escaped from the house of Jacob will no
more again lean on him who struck them,
but shall lean on Yahweh, the Holy One of
Israel, in truth.
21 A remnant will return, even the
remnant of Jacob, to the mighty God.
22 For though your people, Israel, are
like the sand of the sea, only a remnant of
them will return. A destruction is
determined, overflowing with
righteousness.
23 For the Lord, Yahweh of Armies, will
make a full end, and that determined,
throughout all the earth.
24 Therefore the Lord, Yahweh of
Armies, says, "My people who dwell in
Zion, don't be afraid of the Assyrian,
though he strike you with the rod, and lift
up his staff against you, as Egypt did.
25 For yet a very little while, and the
indignation against you will be
accomplished, and my anger will be
directed to his destruction."
26 Yahweh of Armies will stir up a
scourge against him, as in the slaughter of
Midian at the rock of Oreb. His rod will be
over the sea, and he will lift it up like he
did against Egypt.
27 It will happen in that day that his
burden will depart from off your
shoulder, and his yoke from off your neck,
and the yoke shall be destroyed because
of the anointing oil.

28 He has come to Aiath. He has passed
through Migron. At Michmash he stores
his baggage.
29 They have gone over the pass. They
have taken up their lodging at Geba.
Ramah trembles. Gibeah of Saul has fled.
30 Cry aloud with your voice, daughter
of Gallim! Listen, Laishah! You poor
Anathoth!
31 Madmenah is a fugitive. The
inhabitants of Gebim flee for safety.
32 This very day he will halt at Nob. He
shakes his hand at the mountain of the
daughter of Zion, the hill of Jerusalem.
33 Behold, the Lord, Yahweh of Armies,
will lop the boughs with terror. The tall
will be cut down, and the lofty will be
brought low.
34 He will cut down the thickets of the
forest with iron, and Lebanon will fall by
the Mighty One.

11

1 A shoot will come out of the stock of
Jesse,
and a branch out of his roots will bear
fruit.
2 Yahweh's Spirit will rest on him:
the spirit of wisdom and
understanding,
the spirit of counsel and might,
the spirit of knowledge and of the
fear of Yahweh.
3 His delight will be in the fear of Yahweh.
He will not judge by the sight of his eyes,
neither decide by the hearing of his
ears;
4 but he will judge the poor with
righteousness,
and decide with equity for the
humble of the earth.
He will strike the earth with the rod of his
mouth;
and with the breath of his lips he will
kill the wicked.
5 Righteousness will be the belt around his
waist,
and faithfulness the belt around his
waist.

6 The wolf will live with the lamb,
and the leopard will lie down with the
young goat,
the calf, the young lion, and the
fattened calf together;
and a little child will lead them.
7 The cow and the bear will graze.
Their young ones will lie down
together.
The lion will eat straw like the ox.
8 The nursing child will play near a
cobra's hole,
and the weaned child will put his
hand on the viper's den.
9 They will not hurt nor destroy in all my
holy mountain;
for the earth will be full of the
knowledge of Yahweh,
as the waters cover the sea.

10 It will happen in that day that the
nations will seek the root of Jesse, who
stands as a banner of the peoples; and his
resting place will be glorious.
11 It will happen in that day that the
Lord will set his hand again the second
time to recover the remnant that is left of
his people from Assyria, from Egypt, from
Pathros, from Cush, from Elam, from
Shinar, from Hamath, and from the
islands of the sea.
12 He will set up a banner for the
nations, and will assemble the outcasts of
Israel, and gather together the dispersed
of Judah from the four corners of the
earth.
13 The envy also of Ephraim will depart,
and those who persecute Judah will be cut
off. Ephraim won't envy Judah, and Judah
won't persecute Ephraim.
14 They will fly down on the shoulders
of the Philistines on the west. Together
they will plunder the children of the east.
They will extend their power over Edom
and Moab, and the children of Ammon
will obey them.
15 Yahweh will utterly destroy the
tongue of the Egyptian sea; and with his
scorching wind he will wave his hand
over the River, and will split it into seven
streams, and cause men to march over in
sandals.
16 There will be a highway for the
remnant that is left of his people from

Assyria, like there was for Israel in the day that he came up out of the land of Egypt.

12

1 In that day you will say, “I will give thanks to you, Yahweh; for though you were angry with me, your anger has turned away and you comfort me.
2 Behold, God is my salvation. I will trust, and will not be afraid; for Yah, Yahweh, is my strength and song; and he has become my salvation.”
3 Therefore with joy you will draw water out of the wells of salvation.
4 In that day you will say, “Give thanks to Yahweh! Call on his name! Declare his doings among the peoples! Proclaim that his name is exalted!
5 Sing to Yahweh, for he has done excellent things! Let this be known in all the earth!
6 Cry aloud and shout, you inhabitant of Zion, for the Holy One of Israel is great among you!”

13

1 The burden of Babylon, which Isaiah the son of Amoz saw.
2 Set up a banner on the bare mountain! Lift up your voice to them! Wave your hand, that they may go into the gates of the nobles.
3 I have commanded my consecrated ones; yes, I have called my mighty men for my anger, even my proudly exulting ones.
4 The noise of a multitude is in the mountains, as of a great people; the noise of an uproar of the kingdoms of the nations gathered together! Yahweh of Armies is mustering the army for the battle.
5 They come from a far country, from the uttermost part of heaven, even Yahweh, and the weapons of his indignation, to destroy the whole land.
6 Wail, for Yahweh’s day is at hand! It will come as destruction from the Almighty.
7 Therefore all hands will be feeble, and everyone’s heart will melt.
8 They will be dismayed. Pangs and sorrows will seize them. They will be in pain like a woman in labor. They will look in amazement one at another. Their faces will be faces of flame.
9 Behold, the day of Yahweh comes, cruel, with wrath and fierce anger; to make the land a desolation, and to destroy its sinners out of it.
10 For the stars of the sky and its constellations will not give their light. The sun will be darkened in its going out, and the moon will not cause its light to shine.
11 I will punish the world for their evil, and the wicked for their iniquity. I will cause the arrogance of the proud to cease, and will humble the arrogance of the terrible.
12 I will make people more rare than fine gold, even a person than the pure gold of Ophir.
13 Therefore I will make the heavens tremble, and the earth will be shaken out of its place in Yahweh of Armies’ wrath, and in the day of his fierce anger.
14 It will happen that like a hunted gazelle and like sheep that no one gathers, they will each turn to their own people, and will each flee to their own land.
15 Everyone who is found will be thrust through. Everyone who is captured will fall by the sword.
16 Their infants also will be dashed in pieces before their eyes. Their houses will be ransacked, and their wives raped.
17 Behold, I will stir up the Medes against them, who will not value silver, and as for gold, they will not delight in it.
18 Their bows will dash the young men in pieces; and they shall have no pity on the fruit of the womb. Their eyes will not spare children.
19 Babylon, the glory of kingdoms, the beauty of the Chaldeans’ pride, will be like when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah.
20 It will never be inhabited, neither will it be lived in from generation to generation. The Arabian will not pitch a tent there, neither will shepherds make their flocks lie down there.
21 But wild animals of the desert will lie there, and their houses will be full of

jackals. Ostriches will dwell there, and wild goats will frolic there.
22 Hyenas will cry in their fortresses, and jackals in the pleasant palaces. Her time is near to come, and her days will not be prolonged.

14

1 For Yahweh will have compassion on Jacob, and will yet choose Israel, and set them in their own land. The foreigner will join himself with them, and they will unite with the house of Jacob.
2 The peoples will take them, and bring them to their place. The house of Israel will possess them in Yahweh's land for servants and for handmaids. They will take as captives those whose captives they were; and they shall rule over their oppressors.

3 It will happen in the day that Yahweh will give you rest from your sorrow, from your trouble, and from the hard service in which you were made to serve,
4 that you will take up this parable against the king of Babylon, and say, "How the oppressor has ceased! The golden city has ceased!"
5 Yahweh has broken the staff of the wicked, the scepter of the rulers,
6 who struck the peoples in wrath with a continual stroke, who ruled the nations in anger, with a persecution that no one restrained.
7 The whole earth is at rest, and is quiet. They break out in song.
8 Yes, the cypress trees rejoice with you, with the cedars of Lebanon, saying, "Since you are humbled, no lumberjack has come up against us."
9 Sheol† from beneath has moved for you to meet you at your coming. It stirs up the departed spirits for you, even all the rulers of the earth. It has raised up from their thrones all the kings of the nations.
10 They all will answer and ask you, "Have you also become as weak as we are? Have you become like us?"
11 Your pomp is brought down to Sheol,‡ with the sound of your stringed instruments. Maggots are spread out under you, and worms cover you.

12 How you have fallen from heaven, shining one, son of the dawn! How you are cut down to the ground, who laid the nations low!
13 You said in your heart, "I will ascend into heaven! I will exalt my throne above the stars of God! I will sit on the mountain of assembly, in the far north!
14 I will ascend above the heights of the clouds! I will make myself like the Most High!"
15 Yet you shall be brought down to Sheol,§ to the depths of the pit.
16 Those who see you will stare at you. They will ponder you, saying, "Is this the man who made the earth to tremble, who shook kingdoms,
17 who made the world like a wilderness, and overthrew its cities, who didn't release his prisoners to their home?"
18 All the kings of the nations sleep in glory, everyone in his own house.
19 But you are cast away from your tomb like an abominable branch, clothed with the slain who are thrust through with the sword, who go down to the stones of the pit; like a dead body trodden under foot.
20 You will not join them in burial, because you have destroyed your land. You have killed your people. The offspring of evildoers will not be named forever.
21 Prepare for slaughter of his children because of the iniquity of their fathers, that they not rise up and possess the earth, and fill the surface of the world with cities.
22 "I will rise up against them," says Yahweh of Armies, "and cut off from Babylon name and remnant, and son and son's son," says Yahweh.
23 "I will also make it a possession for the porcupine, and pools of water. I will sweep it with the broom of destruction," says Yahweh of Armies.

† **14:9** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **14:11** Sheol is the place of the dead. § **14:15** Sheol is the place of the dead.

24 Yahweh of Armies has sworn, saying,
“Surely, as I have thought, so shall it
happen; and as I have purposed, so shall it
stand:
25 that I will break the Assyrian in my
land, and tread him under foot on my
mountains. Then his yoke will leave them,
and his burden leave their shoulders.
26 This is the plan that is determined for
the whole earth. This is the hand that is
stretched out over all the nations.
27 For Yahweh of Armies has planned,
and who can stop it? His hand is stretched
out, and who can turn it back?”
28 This burden was in the year that King
Ahaz died.
29 Don’t rejoice, O Philistia, all of you,
because the rod that struck you is broken;
for out of the serpent’s root an adder will
emerge, and his fruit will be a fiery flying
serpent.
30 The firstborn of the poor will eat, and
the needy will lie down in safety; and I
will kill your root with famine, and your
remnant will be killed.
31 Howl, gate! Cry, city! You are melted
away, Philistia, all of you; for smoke
comes out of the north, and there is no
straggler in his ranks.
32 What will they answer the
messengers of the nation? That Yahweh
has founded Zion, and in her the afflicted
of his people will take refuge.

15

1 The burden of Moab.
For in a night, Ar of Moab is laid waste,
and brought to nothing. For in a night Kir
of Moab is laid waste, and brought to
nothing.
2 They have gone up to Bayith, and to
Dibon, to the high places, to weep. Moab
wails over Nebo and over Medeba.
Baldness is on all of their heads. Every
beard is cut off.
3 In their streets, they clothe themselves
in sackcloth. In their streets and on their
housetops, everyone wails, weeping
abundantly.
4 Heshbon cries out with Elealeh. Their
voice is heard even to Jahaz. Therefore
the armed men of Moab cry aloud. Their
souls tremble within them.
5 My heart cries out for Moab! Her
nobles flee to Zoar, to Eglath Shelishiyah;
for they go up by the ascent of Luhith with
weeping; for on the way to Horonaim,
they raise up a cry of destruction.
6 For the waters of Nimrim will be
desolate; for the grass has withered away,
the tender grass fails, there is no green
thing.
7 Therefore they will carry away the
abundance they have gotten, and that
which they have stored up, over the brook
of the willows.
8 For the cry has gone around the
borders of Moab, its wailing to Eglaim,
and its wailing to Beer Elim.
9 For the waters of Dimon are full of
blood; for I will bring yet more on Dimon,
a lion on those of Moab who escape, and
on the remnant of the land.

16

1 Send the lambs for the ruler of the
land from Selah to the wilderness, to the
mountain of the daughter of Zion.
2 For it will be that as wandering birds,
as a scattered nest, so will the daughters
of Moab be at the fords of the Arnon.
3 Give counsel! Execute justice! Make
your shade like the night in the middle of
the noonday! Hide the outcasts! Don’t
betray the fugitive!
4 Let my outcasts dwell with you! As for
Moab, be a hiding place for him from the
face of the destroyer. For the extortionist
is brought to nothing. Destruction ceases.
The oppressors are consumed out of the
land.
5 A throne will be established in loving
kindness. One will sit on it in truth, in the
tent of David, judging, seeking justice, and
swift to do righteousness.
6 We have heard of the pride of Moab,
that he is very proud; even of his
arrogance, his pride, and his wrath. His
boastings are nothing.
7 Therefore Moab will wail for Moab.
Everyone will wail. You will mourn for
the raisin cakes of Kir Hareseth, utterly
stricken.
8 For the fields of Heshbon languish
with the vine of Sibmah. The lords of the

nations have broken down its choice branches, which reached even to Jazer, which wandered into the wilderness. Its shoots were spread abroad. They passed over the sea.
9 Therefore I will weep with the weeping of Jazer for the vine of Sibmah. I will water you with my tears, Heshbon, and Elealeh: for on your summer fruits and on your harvest the battle shout has fallen.
10 Gladness is taken away, and joy out of the fruitful field; and in the vineyards there will be no singing, neither joyful noise. Nobody will tread out wine in the presses. I have made the shouting stop.
11 Therefore my heart sounds like a harp for Moab, and my inward parts for Kir Heres.
12 It will happen that when Moab presents himself, when he wearies himself on the high place, and comes to his sanctuary to pray, that he will not prevail.
13 This is the word that Yahweh spoke concerning Moab in time past.
14 But now Yahweh has spoken, saying, "Within three years, as a worker bound by contract would count them, the glory of Moab shall be brought into contempt, with all his great multitude; and the remnant will be very small and feeble."

17

1 The burden of Damascus.
"Behold, Damascus is taken away from being a city, and it will be a ruinous heap.
2 The cities of Aroer are forsaken. They will be for flocks, which shall lie down, and no one shall make them afraid.
3 The fortress shall cease from Ephraim, and the kingdom from Damascus, and the remnant of Syria. They will be as the glory of the children of Israel," says Yahweh of Armies.
4 "It will happen in that day that the glory of Jacob will be made thin, and the fatness of his flesh will become lean.
5 It will be like when the harvester gathers the wheat, and his arm reaps the grain. Yes, it will be like when one gleans grain in the valley of Rephaim.
6 Yet gleanings will be left there, like the shaking of an olive tree, two or three olives in the top of the uppermost bough, four or five in the outermost branches of a fruitful tree," says Yahweh, the God of Israel.
7 In that day, people will look to their Maker, and their eyes will have respect for the Holy One of Israel.
8 They will not look to the altars, the work of their hands; neither shall they respect that which their fingers have made, either the Asherah poles or the incense altars.
9 In that day, their strong cities will be like the forsaken places in the woods and on the mountain top, which were forsaken from before the children of Israel; and it will be a desolation.
10 For you have forgotten the God of your salvation, and have not remembered the rock of your strength. Therefore you plant pleasant plants, and set out foreign seedlings.
11 In the day of your planting, you hedge it in. In the morning, you make your seed blossom, but the harvest flees away in the day of grief and of desperate sorrow.
12 Ah, the uproar of many peoples who roar like the roaring of the seas; and the rushing of nations that rush like the rushing of mighty waters!
13 The nations will rush like the rushing of many waters, but he will rebuke them, and they will flee far off, and will be chased like the chaff of the mountains before the wind, and like the whirling dust before the storm.
14 At evening, behold, terror! Before the morning, they are no more. This is the portion of those who plunder us, and the lot of those who rob us.

18

1 Ah, the land of the rustling of wings, which is beyond the rivers of Ethiopia;
2 that sends ambassadors by the sea, even in vessels of papyrus on the waters, saying, "Go, you swift messengers, to a nation tall and smooth, to a people awesome from their beginning onward, a

nation that measures out and treads
down, whose land the rivers divide!"
3 All you inhabitants of the world, and
you dwellers on the earth, when a banner
is lifted up on the mountains, look! When
the trumpet is blown, listen!
4 For Yahweh said to me, "I will be still,
and I will see in my dwelling place, like
clear heat in sunshine, like a cloud of dew
in the heat of harvest."
5 For before the harvest, when the
blossom is over, and the flower becomes a
ripening grape, he will cut off the sprigs
with pruning hooks, and he will cut down
and take away the spreading branches.
6 They will be left together for the
ravenous birds of the mountains, and for
the animals of the earth. The ravenous
birds will eat them in the summer, and all
the animals of the earth will eat them in
the winter.
7 In that time, a present will be brought
to Yahweh of Armies from a people tall
and smooth, even from a people awesome
from their beginning onward, a nation
that measures out and treads down,
whose land the rivers divide, to the place
of the name of Yahweh of Armies, Mount
Zion.

19

1 The burden of Egypt.

"Behold, Yahweh rides on a swift cloud,
and comes to Egypt. The idols of Egypt
will tremble at his presence; and the heart
of Egypt will melt within it.
2 I will stir up the Egyptians against the
Egyptians, and they will fight everyone
against his brother, and everyone against
his neighbor; city against city, and
kingdom against kingdom.
3 The spirit of the Egyptians will fail
within them. I will destroy their counsel.
They will seek the idols, the charmers,
those who have familiar spirits, and the
wizards.
4 I will give over the Egyptians into the
hand of a cruel lord. A fierce king will rule
over them," says the Lord, Yahweh of
Armies.
5 The waters will fail from the sea, and
the river will be wasted and become dry.
6 The rivers will become foul. The
streams of Egypt will be diminished and
dried up. The reeds and flags will wither
away.
7 The meadows by the Nile, by the brink
of the Nile, and all the sown fields of the
Nile, will become dry, be driven away,
and be no more.
8 The fishermen will lament, and all
those who fish in the Nile will mourn, and
those who spread nets on the waters will
languish.
9 Moreover those who work in combed
flax, and those who weave white cloth,
will be confounded.
10 The pillars will be broken in pieces.
All those who work for hire will be
grieved in soul.
11 The princes of Zoan are utterly
foolish. The counsel of the wisest
counselors of Pharaoh has become stupid.
How do you say to Pharaoh, "I am the son
of the wise, the son of ancient kings"?
12 Where then are your wise men? Let
them tell you now; and let them know
what Yahweh of Armies has purposed
concerning Egypt.
13 The princes of Zoan have become
fools. The princes of Memphis are
deceived. They have caused Egypt to go
astray, those who are the cornerstone of
her tribes.
14 Yahweh has mixed a spirit of
perverseness in the middle of her; and
they have caused Egypt to go astray in all
of its works, like a drunken man staggers
in his vomit.
15 Neither shall there be any work for
Egypt, which head or tail, palm branch or
rush, may do.
16 In that day the Egyptians will be like
women. They will tremble and fear
because of the shaking of Yahweh of
Armies's hand, which he shakes over
them.
17 The land of Judah will become a
terror to Egypt. Everyone to whom
mention is made of it will be afraid,
because of the plans of Yahweh of Armies,
which he determines against it.
18 In that day, there will be five cities in
the land of Egypt that speak the language

of Canaan, and swear to Yahweh of Armies. One will be called "The city of destruction."
19 In that day, there will be an altar to Yahweh in the middle of the land of Egypt, and a pillar to Yahweh at its border.
20 It will be for a sign and for a witness to Yahweh of Armies in the land of Egypt; for they will cry to Yahweh because of oppressors, and he will send them a savior and a defender, and he will deliver them.
21 Yahweh will be known to Egypt, and the Egyptians will know Yahweh in that day. Yes, they will worship with sacrifice and offering, and will vow a vow to Yahweh, and will perform it.
22 Yahweh will strike Egypt, striking and healing. They will return to Yahweh, and he will be entreated by them, and will heal them.
23 In that day there will be a highway out of Egypt to Assyria, and the Assyrian shall come into Egypt, and the Egyptian into Assyria; and the Egyptians will worship with the Assyrians.
24 In that day, Israel will be the third with Egypt and with Assyria, a blessing within the earth;
25 because Yahweh of Armies has blessed them, saying, "Blessed be Egypt my people, Assyria the work of my hands, and Israel my inheritance."

20

1 In the year that Tartan came to Ashdod, when Sargon the king of Assyria sent him, and he fought against Ashdod and took it;
2 at that time Yahweh spoke by Isaiah the son of Amoz, saying, "Go, and loosen the sackcloth from off your waist, and take your sandals from off your feet." He did so, walking naked and barefoot.
3 Yahweh said, "As my servant Isaiah has walked naked and barefoot three years for a sign and a wonder concerning Egypt and concerning Ethiopia,
4 so the king of Assyria will lead away the captives of Egypt and the exiles of Ethiopia, young and old, naked and barefoot, and with buttocks uncovered, to the shame of Egypt.
5 They will be dismayed and confounded, because of Ethiopia their expectation, and of Egypt their glory.
6 The inhabitants of this coast land will say in that day, 'Behold, this is our expectation, where we fled for help to be delivered from the king of Assyria. And we, how will we escape?' "

21

1 The burden of the wilderness of the sea.
As whirlwinds in the South sweep through, it comes from the wilderness, from an awesome land.
2 A grievous vision is declared to me. The treacherous man deals treacherously, and the destroyer destroys. Go up, Elam; attack! I have stopped all of Media's sighing.
3 Therefore my thighs are filled with anguish. Pains have seized me, like the pains of a woman in labor. I am in so much pain that I can't hear. I am so dismayed that I can't see.
4 My heart flutters. Horror has frightened me. The twilight that I desired has been turned into trembling for me.
5 They prepare the table. They set the watch. They eat. They drink. Rise up, you princes, oil the shield!
6 For the Lord said to me, "Go, set a watchman. Let him declare what he sees.
7 When he sees a troop, horsemen in pairs, a troop of donkeys, a troop of camels, he shall listen diligently with great attentiveness."
8 He cried like a lion: "Lord, I stand continually on the watchtower in the daytime, and every night I stay at my post.
9 Behold, here comes a troop of men, horsemen in pairs." He answered, "Fallen, fallen is Babylon; and all the engraved images of her gods are broken to the ground.
10 You are my threshing, and the grain of my floor!" That which I have heard from Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, I have declared to you.

11 The burden of Dumah.
One calls to me out of Seir, "Watchman, what of the night? Watchman, what of the night?"
12 The watchman said, "The morning comes, and also the night. If you will inquire, inquire. Come back again."
13 The burden on Arabia.
You will lodge in the thickets in Arabia, you caravans of Dedanites.
14 They brought water to him who was thirsty. The inhabitants of the land of Tema met the fugitives with their bread.
15 For they fled away from the swords, from the drawn sword, from the bent bow, and from the heat of battle.
16 For the Lord said to me, "Within a year, as a worker bound by contract would count it, all the glory of Kedar will fail,
17 and the residue of the number of the archers, the mighty men of the children of Kedar, will be few; for Yahweh, the God of Israel, has spoken it."

22

1 The burden of the valley of vision.
What ails you now, that you have all gone up to the housetops?
2 You that are full of shouting, a tumultuous city, a joyous town, your slain are not slain with the sword, neither are they dead in battle.
3 All your rulers fled away together. They were bound by the archers. All who were found by you were bound together. They fled far away.
4 Therefore I said, "Look away from me. I will weep bitterly. Don't labor to comfort me for the destruction of the daughter of my people.
5 For it is a day of confusion, and of treading down, and of perplexity from the Lord, Yahweh of Armies, in the valley of vision, a breaking down of the walls, and a crying to the mountains."
6 Elam carried his quiver, with chariots of men and horsemen; and Kir uncovered the shield.
7 Your choicest valleys were full of chariots, and the horsemen set themselves in array at the gate.
8 He took away the covering of Judah; and you looked in that day to the armor in the house of the forest.
9 You saw the breaches of David's city, that they were many; and you gathered together the waters of the lower pool.
10 You counted the houses of Jerusalem, and you broke down the houses to fortify the wall.
11 You also made a reservoir between the two walls for the water of the old pool. But you didn't look to him who had done this, neither did you have respect for him who planned it long ago.

12 In that day, the Lord, Yahweh of Armies, called to weeping, to mourning, to baldness, and to dressing in sackcloth;
13 and behold, there is joy and gladness, killing cattle and killing sheep, eating meat and drinking wine: "Let's eat and drink, for tomorrow we will die."
14 Yahweh of Armies revealed himself in my ears, "Surely this iniquity will not be forgiven you until you die," says the Lord, Yahweh of Armies.

15 The Lord, Yahweh of Armies says, "Go, get yourself to this treasurer, even to Shebna, who is over the house, and say,
16 'What are you doing here? Who has you here, that you have dug out a tomb here?' Cutting himself out a tomb on high, chiseling a habitation for himself in the rock!"
17 Behold, Yahweh will overcome you and hurl you away violently. Yes, he will grasp you firmly.
18 He will surely wind you around and around, and throw you like a ball into a large country. There you will die, and there the chariots of your glory will be, you disgrace of your lord's house.
19 I will thrust you from your office. You will be pulled down from your station.

20 It will happen in that day that I will call my servant Eliakim the son of Hilkiah,
21 and I will clothe him with your robe, and strengthen him with your belt. I will commit your government into his hand; and he will be a father to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and to the house of Judah.

22 I will lay the key of David's house on
his shoulder. He will open, and no one
will shut. He will shut, and no one will
open.
23 I will fasten him like a nail in a sure
place. He will be for a throne of glory to
his father's house.
24 They will hang on him all the glory of
his father's house, the offspring and the
issue, every small vessel, from the cups
even to all the pitchers.
25 "In that day," says Yahweh of Armies,
"the nail that was fastened in a sure place
will give way. It will be cut down and fall.
The burden that was on it will be cut off,
for Yahweh has spoken it."

23

1 The burden of Tyre.

Howl, you ships of Tarshish! For it is
laid waste, so that there is no house, no
entering in. From the land of Kittim it is
revealed to them.
2 Be still, you inhabitants of the coast,
you whom the merchants of Sidon that
pass over the sea have replenished.
3 On great waters, the seed of the
Shihor, the harvest of the Nile, was her
revenue. She was the market of nations.
4 Be ashamed, Sidon; for the sea has
spoken, the stronghold of the sea, saying,
"I have not travailed, nor given birth,
neither have I nourished young men, nor
brought up virgins."
5 When the report comes to Egypt, they
will be in anguish at the report of Tyre.
6 Pass over to Tarshish! Wail, you
inhabitants of the coast!
7 Is this your joyous city, whose
antiquity is of ancient days, whose feet
carried her far away to travel?
8 Who has planned this against Tyre, the
giver of crowns, whose merchants are
princes, whose traders are the honorable
of the earth?
9 Yahweh of Armies has planned it, to
stain the pride of all glory, to bring into
contempt all the honorable of the earth.
10 Pass through your land like the Nile,
daughter of Tarshish. There is no
restraint any more.
11 He has stretched out his hand over
the sea. He has shaken the kingdoms.
Yahweh has ordered the destruction of
Canaan's strongholds.
12 He said, "You shall rejoice no more,
you oppressed virgin daughter of Sidon.
Arise, pass over to Kittim. Even there you
will have no rest."
13 Behold, the land of the Chaldeans.
This people didn't exist. The Assyrians
founded it for those who dwell in the
wilderness. They set up their towers.
They overthrew its palaces. They made it
a ruin.
14 Howl, you ships of Tarshish, for your
stronghold is laid waste!
15 It will come to pass in that day that
Tyre will be forgotten seventy years,
according to the days of one king. After
the end of seventy years it will be to Tyre
like in the song of the prostitute.
16 Take a harp; go about the city, you
prostitute that has been forgotten. Make
sweet melody. Sing many songs, that you
may be remembered.
17 It will happen after the end of seventy
years that Yahweh will visit Tyre. She will
return to her wages, and will play the
prostitute with all the kingdoms of the
world on the surface of the earth.
18 Her merchandise and her wages will
be holiness to Yahweh. It will not be
treasured nor laid up; for her
merchandise will be for those who dwell
before Yahweh, to eat sufficiently, and for
durable clothing.

24

1 Behold, Yahweh makes the earth
empty, makes it waste, turns it upside
down, and scatters its inhabitants.
2 It will be as with the people, so with
the priest; as with the servant, so with his
master; as with the maid, so with her
mistress; as with the buyer, so with the
seller; as with the creditor, so with the
debtor; as with the taker of interest, so
with the giver of interest.
3 The earth will be utterly emptied and
utterly laid waste; for Yahweh has spoken
this word.

4 The earth mourns and fades away.
The world languishes and fades away.
The lofty people of the earth languish.
5 The earth also is polluted under its
inhabitants, because they have
transgressed the laws, violated the
statutes, and broken the everlasting
covenant.
6 Therefore the curse has devoured the
earth, and those who dwell therein are
found guilty. Therefore the inhabitants of
the earth are burned, and few men are
left.
7 The new wine mourns. The vine
languishes. All the merry-hearted sigh.
8 The mirth of tambourines ceases. The
sound of those who rejoice ends. The joy
of the harp ceases.
9 They will not drink wine with a song.
Strong drink will be bitter to those who
drink it.
10 The confused city is broken down.
Every house is shut up, that no man may
come in.
11 There is a crying in the streets
because of the wine. All joy is darkened.
The mirth of the land is gone.
12 The city is left in desolation, and the
gate is struck with destruction.
13 For it will be so within the earth
among the peoples, as the shaking of an
olive tree, as the gleanings when the
vintage is done.
14 These shall lift up their voice. They
will shout for the majesty of Yahweh.
They cry aloud from the sea.
15 Therefore glorify Yahweh in the east,
even the name of Yahweh, the God of
Israel, in the islands of the sea!
16 From the uttermost part of the earth
have we heard songs. Glory to the
righteous!

But I said, “I pine away! I pine away!
woe is me!” The treacherous have dealt
treacherously. Yes, the treacherous have
dealt very treacherously.
17 Fear, the pit, and the snare are on you
who inhabit the earth.
18 It will happen that he who flees from
the noise of the fear will fall into the pit;
and he who comes up out of the middle of
the pit will be taken in the snare; for the
windows on high are opened, and the
foundations of the earth tremble.
19 The earth is utterly broken. The earth
is torn apart. The earth is shaken
violently.
20 The earth will stagger like a drunken
man, and will sway back and forth like a
hammock. Its disobedience will be heavy
on it, and it will fall and not rise again.
21 It will happen in that day that Yahweh
will punish the army of the high ones on
high, and the kings of the earth on the
earth.
22 They will be gathered together, as
prisoners are gathered in the pit, and will
be shut up in the prison; and after many
days they will be visited.
23 Then the moon will be confounded,
and the sun ashamed; for Yahweh of
Armies will reign on Mount Zion and in
Jerusalem; and glory will be before his
elders.

25

1 Yahweh, you are my God. I will exalt
you! I will praise your name, for you have
done wonderful things, things planned
long ago, in complete faithfulness and
truth.
2 For you have made a city into a heap, a
fortified city into a ruin, a palace of
strangers to be no city. It will never be
built.
3 Therefore a strong people will glorify
you. A city of awesome nations will fear
you.
4 For you have been a stronghold to the
poor, a stronghold to the needy in his
distress, a refuge from the storm, a shade
from the heat, when the blast of the
dreaded ones is like a storm against the
wall.
5 As the heat in a dry place you will
bring down the noise of strangers; as the
heat by the shade of a cloud, the song of
the dreaded ones will be brought low.
6 In this mountain, Yahweh of Armies
will make all peoples a feast of choice
meat,† a feast of choice wines, of choice

† **25:6** literally, fat things

meat full of marrow, of well refined
choice wines.
7 He will destroy in this mountain the
surface of the covering that covers all
peoples, and the veil that is spread over
all nations.
8 He has swallowed up death forever!
The Lord Yahweh will wipe away tears
from off all faces. He will take the
reproach of his people away from off all
the earth, for Yahweh has spoken it.
9 It shall be said in that day, “Behold,
this is our God! We have waited for him,
and he will save us! This is Yahweh! We
have waited for him. We will be glad and
rejoice in his salvation!”
10 For Yahweh’s hand will rest in this
mountain.
Moab will be trodden down in his place,
even like straw is trodden down in the
water of the dunghill.
11 He will spread out his hands in the
middle of it, like one who swims spreads
out hands to swim, but his pride will be
humbled together with the craft of his
hands.
12 He has brought the high fortress of
your walls down, laid low, and brought to
the ground, even to the dust.

26

1 In that day, this song will be sung in
the land of Judah:
“We have a strong city.
God appoints salvation for walls and
bulwarks.
2 Open the gates, that the righteous nation
may enter:
the one which keeps faith.
3 You will keep whoever’s mind is
steadfast in perfect peace,
because he trusts in you.
4 Trust in Yahweh forever;
for in Yah, Yahweh, is an everlasting
Rock.
5 For he has brought down those who
dwell on high, the lofty city.
He lays it low.
He lays it low even to the ground.
He brings it even to the dust.
6 The foot shall tread it down,
even the feet of the poor
and the steps of the needy.”
7 The way of the just is uprightness.
You who are upright make the path of
the righteous level.

8 Yes, in the way of your judgments,
Yahweh, we have waited for you.
Your name and your renown are the
desire of our soul.
9 With my soul I have desired you in the
night.
Yes, with my spirit within me I will
seek you earnestly;
for when your judgments are in the
earth, the inhabitants of the world
learn righteousness.
10 Let favor be shown to the wicked,
yet he will not learn righteousness.
In the land of uprightness he will deal
wrongfully,
and will not see Yahweh’s majesty.

11 Yahweh, your hand is lifted up, yet they
don’t see;
but they will see your zeal for the
people and be disappointed.
Yes, fire will consume your
adversaries.
12 Yahweh, you will ordain peace for us,
for you have also done all our work
for us.
13 Yahweh our God, other lords besides
you have had dominion over us,
but we will only acknowledge your
name.
14 The dead shall not live.
The departed spirits shall not rise.
Therefore you have visited and destroyed
them,
and caused all memory of them to
perish.
15 You have increased the nation, O
Yahweh.
You have increased the nation!
You are glorified!
You have enlarged all the borders of
the land.

16 Yahweh, in trouble they have visited
you.
They poured out a prayer when your
chastening was on them.
17 Just as a woman with child, who draws
near the time of her delivery,

is in pain and cries out in her pangs,
so we have been before you, Yahweh.
18 We have been with child.
We have been in pain.
We gave birth, it seems, only to wind.
We have not worked any deliverance in the earth;
neither have the inhabitants of the world fallen.
19 Your dead shall live.
Their dead bodies shall arise.
Awake and sing, you who dwell in the dust;
for your dew is like the dew of herbs,
and the earth will cast out the departed spirits.

20 Come, my people, enter into your rooms,
and shut your doors behind you.
Hide yourself for a little moment,
until the indignation is past.
21 For, behold, Yahweh comes out of his place to punish the inhabitants of the earth for their iniquity.
The earth also will disclose her blood,
and will no longer cover her slain.

27

1 In that day, Yahweh with his hard and great and strong sword will punish leviathan, the fleeing serpent, and leviathan, the twisted serpent; and he will kill the dragon that is in the sea.

2 In that day, sing to her, “A pleasant vineyard!

3 I, Yahweh, am its keeper. I will water it every moment. Lest anyone damage it, I will keep it night and day.

4 Wrath is not in me, but if I should find briers and thorns, I would do battle! I would march on them and I would burn them together.

5 Or else let him take hold of my strength, that he may make peace with me. Let him make peace with me.”

6 In days to come, Jacob will take root. Israel will blossom and bud. They will fill the surface of the world with fruit.

7 Has he struck them as he struck those who struck them? Or are they killed like those who killed them were killed?

8 In measure, when you send them away, you contend with them. He has removed them with his rough blast in the day of the east wind.

9 Therefore by this the iniquity of Jacob will be forgiven, and this is all the fruit of taking away his sin: that he makes all the stones of the altar as chalk stones that are beaten in pieces, so that the Asherah poles and the incense altars shall rise no more.

10 For the fortified city is solitary, a habitation deserted and forsaken, like the wilderness. The calf will feed there, and there he will lie down, and consume its branches.

11 When its boughs are withered, they will be broken off. The women will come and set them on fire, for they are a people of no understanding. Therefore he who made them will not have compassion on them, and he who formed them will show them no favor.

12 It will happen in that day that Yahweh will thresh from the flowing stream of the Euphrates to the brook of Egypt; and you will be gathered one by one, children of Israel.

13 It will happen in that day that a great trumpet will be blown; and those who were ready to perish in the land of Assyria, and those who were outcasts in the land of Egypt, shall come; and they will worship Yahweh in the holy mountain at Jerusalem.

28

1 Woe to the crown of pride of the drunkards of Ephraim, and to the fading flower of his glorious beauty, which is on the head of the fertile valley of those who are overcome with wine!

2 Behold, the Lord has one who is mighty and strong. Like a storm of hail, a destroying storm, and like a storm of mighty waters overflowing, he will cast them down to the earth with his hand.

3 The crown of pride of the drunkards of Ephraim will be trodden under foot.

4 The fading flower of his glorious beauty, which is on the head of the fertile valley, shall be like the first-ripe fig before

the summer, which someone picks and eats as soon as he sees it.
5 In that day, Yahweh of Armies will become a crown of glory and a diadem of beauty to the residue of his people,
6 and a spirit of justice to him who sits in judgment, and strength to those who turn back the battle at the gate.
7 They also reel with wine, and stagger with strong drink. The priest and the prophet reel with strong drink. They are swallowed up by wine. They stagger with strong drink. They err in vision. They stumble in judgment.
8 For all tables are completely full of filthy vomit and filthiness.
9 Whom will he teach knowledge? To whom will he explain the message? Those who are weaned from the milk, and drawn from the breasts?
10 For it is precept on precept, precept on precept; line on line, line on line; here a little, there a little.
11 But he will speak to this nation with stammering lips and in another language,
12 to whom he said, "This is the resting place. Give rest to the weary," and "This is the refreshing;" yet they would not hear.
13 Therefore Yahweh's word will be to them precept on precept, precept on precept; line on line, line on line; here a little, there a little; that they may go, fall backward, be broken, be snared, and be taken.
14 Therefore hear Yahweh's word, you scoffers, that rule this people in Jerusalem:
15 "Because you have said, 'We have made a covenant with death, and we are in agreement with Sheol.† When the overflowing scourge passes through, it won't come to us; for we have made lies our refuge, and we have hidden ourselves under falsehood.' "
16 Therefore the Lord Yahweh says, "Behold, I lay in Zion for a foundation a stone, a tried stone, a precious cornerstone of a sure foundation. He who believes shall not act hastily.
17 I will make justice the measuring line, and righteousness the plumb line. The hail will sweep away the refuge of lies, and the waters will overflow the hiding place.
18 Your covenant with death shall be annulled, and your agreement with Sheol‡ shall not stand. When the overflowing scourge passes through, then you will be trampled down by it.
19 As often as it passes through, it will seize you; for morning by morning it will pass through, by day and by night; and it will be nothing but terror to understand the message."
20 For the bed is too short to stretch out on, and the blanket is too narrow to wrap oneself in.
21 For Yahweh will rise up as on Mount Perazim. He will be angry as in the valley of Gibeon; that he may do his work, his unusual work, and bring to pass his act, his extraordinary act.
22 Now therefore don't be scoffers, lest your bonds be made strong; for I have heard a decree of destruction from the Lord, Yahweh of Armies, on the whole earth.
23 Give ear, and hear my voice! Listen, and hear my speech!
24 Does he who plows to sow plow continually? Does he keep turning the soil and breaking the clods?
25 When he has leveled its surface, doesn't he plant the dill, and scatter the cumin seed, and put in the wheat in rows, the barley in the appointed place, and the spelt in its place?
26 For his God instructs him in right judgment and teaches him.
27 For the dill isn't threshed with a sharp instrument, neither is a cart wheel turned over the cumin; but the dill is beaten out with a stick, and the cumin with a rod.
28 Bread flour must be ground; so he will not always be threshing it. Although he drives the wheel of his threshing cart over it, his horses don't grind it.
29 This also comes out from Yahweh of Armies, who is wonderful in counsel, and

† **28:15** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **28:18** Sheol is the place of the dead.

excellent in wisdom.

29

1 Woe to Ariel! Ariel, the city where
David encamped! Add year to year; let the
feasts come around;
2 then I will distress Ariel, and there will
be mourning and lamentation. She shall
be to me as an altar hearth.†
3 I will encamp against you all around
you, and will lay siege against you with
posted troops. I will raise siege works
against you.
4 You will be brought down, and will
speak out of the ground. Your speech will
mumble out of the dust. Your voice will be
as of one who has a familiar spirit, out of
the ground, and your speech will whisper
out of the dust.
5 But the multitude of your foes will be
like fine dust, and the multitude of the
ruthless ones like chaff that blows away.
Yes, it will be in an instant, suddenly.
6 She will be visited by Yahweh of
Armies with thunder, with earthquake,
with great noise, with whirlwind and
storm, and with the flame of a devouring
fire.
7 The multitude of all the nations that
fight against Ariel, even all who fight
against her and her stronghold, and who
distress her, will be like a dream, a vision
of the night.
8 It will be like when a hungry man
dreams, and behold, he eats; but he
awakes, and his hunger isn't satisfied; or
like when a thirsty man dreams, and
behold, he drinks; but he awakes, and
behold, he is faint, and he is still thirsty.
The multitude of all the nations that fight
against Mount Zion will be like that.
9 Pause and wonder! Blind yourselves
and be blind! They are drunken, but not
with wine; they stagger, but not with
strong drink.
10 For Yahweh has poured out on you a
spirit of deep sleep, and has closed your
eyes, the prophets; and he has covered
your heads, the seers.
11 All vision has become to you like the
words of a book that is sealed, which men
deliver to one who is educated, saying,
"Read this, please;" and he says, "I can't,
for it is sealed;"
12 and the book is delivered to one who
is not educated, saying, "Read this,
please;" and he says, "I can't read."

13 The Lord said, "Because this people
draws near with their mouth and honors
me with their lips, but they have removed
their heart far from me, and their fear of
me is a commandment of men which has
been taught;
14 therefore, behold, I will proceed to do
a marvelous work among this people,
even a marvelous work and a wonder;
and the wisdom of their wise men will
perish, and the understanding of their
prudent men will be hidden."

15 Woe to those who deeply hide their
counsel from Yahweh, and whose deeds
are in the dark, and who say, "Who sees
us?" and "Who knows us?"
16 You turn things upside down! Should
the potter be thought to be like clay, that
the thing made should say about him who
made it, "He didn't make me;" or the thing
formed say of him who formed it, "He has
no understanding"?

17 Isn't it yet a very little while, and
Lebanon will be turned into a fruitful
field, and the fruitful field will be
regarded as a forest?
18 In that day, the deaf will hear the
words of the book, and the eyes of the
blind will see out of obscurity and out of
darkness.
19 The humble also will increase their
joy in Yahweh, and the poor among men
will rejoice in the Holy One of Israel.
20 For the ruthless is brought to nothing,
and the scoffer ceases, and all those who
are alert to do evil are cut off—
21 who cause a person to be indicted by
a word, and lay a snare for one who
reproves in the gate, and who deprive the
innocent of justice with false testimony.

22 Therefore Yahweh, who redeemed
Abraham, says concerning the house of
Jacob: "Jacob shall no longer be ashamed,
neither shall his face grow pale.

† **29:2** or, Ariel

23 But when he sees his children, the
work of my hands, in the middle of him,
they will sanctify my name. Yes, they will
sanctify the Holy One of Jacob, and will
stand in awe of the God of Israel.
24 They also who err in spirit will come
to understanding, and those who grumble
will receive instruction."

30

1 "Woe to the rebellious children", says
Yahweh, "who take counsel, but not from
me; and who make an alliance, but not
with my Spirit, that they may add sin to
sin;
2 who set out to go down into Egypt
without asking for my advice, to
strengthen themselves in the strength of
Pharaoh, and to take refuge in the shadow
of Egypt!
3 Therefore the strength of Pharaoh will
be your shame, and the refuge in the
shadow of Egypt your confusion.
4 For their princes are at Zoan, and their
ambassadors have come to Hanes.
5 They shall all be ashamed because of a
people that can't profit them, that are not
a help nor profit, but a shame, and also a
reproach."
6 The burden of the animals of the
South.
Through the land of trouble and
anguish, of the lioness and the lion, the
viper and fiery flying serpent, they carry
their riches on the shoulders of young
donkeys, and their treasures on the
humps of camels, to an unprofitable
people.
7 For Egypt helps in vain, and to no
purpose; therefore I have called her
Rahab who sits still.
8 Now go, write it before them on a
tablet, and inscribe it in a book, that it may
be for the time to come forever and ever.
9 For it is a rebellious people, lying
children, children who will not hear
Yahweh's law;
10 who tell the seers, "Don't see!" and
the prophets, "Don't prophesy to us right
things. Tell us pleasant things. Prophesy
deceits.
11 Get out of the way. Turn away from
the path. Cause the Holy One of Israel to
cease from before us."
12 Therefore the Holy One of Israel says,
"Because you despise this word, and trust
in oppression and perverseness, and rely
on it,
13 therefore this iniquity shall be to you
like a breach ready to fall, swelling out in
a high wall, whose breaking comes
suddenly in an instant.
14 He will break it as a potter's vessel is
broken, breaking it in pieces without
sparing, so that there won't be found
among the broken pieces a piece good
enough to take fire from the hearth, or to
dip up water out of the cistern."
15 For thus said the Lord Yahweh, the
Holy One of Israel, "You will be saved in
returning and rest. Your strength will be
in quietness and in confidence." You
refused,
16 but you said, "No, for we will flee on
horses;" therefore you will flee; and, "We
will ride on the swift;" therefore those
who pursue you will be swift.
17 One thousand will flee at the threat of
one. At the threat of five, you will flee
until you are left like a beacon on the top
of a mountain, and like a banner on a hill.
18 Therefore Yahweh will wait, that he
may be gracious to you; and therefore he
will be exalted, that he may have mercy
on you, for Yahweh is a God of justice.
Blessed are all those who wait for him.
19 For the people will dwell in Zion at
Jerusalem. You will weep no more. He
will surely be gracious to you at the voice
of your cry. When he hears you, he will
answer you.
20 Though the Lord may give you the
bread of adversity and the water of
affliction, yet your teachers won't be
hidden any more, but your eyes will see
your teachers;
21 and when you turn to the right hand,
and when you turn to the left, your ears
will hear a voice behind you, saying, "This
is the way. Walk in it."
22 You shall defile the overlaying of your
engraved images of silver, and the plating

of your molten images of gold. You shall cast them away as an unclean thing. You shall tell it, “Go away!”

23 He will give the rain for your seed,
with which you will sow the ground; and
bread of the increase of the ground will be
rich and plentiful. In that day, your
livestock will feed in large pastures.
24 The oxen likewise and the young
donkeys that till the ground will eat
savory feed, which has been winnowed
with the shovel and with the fork.
25 There will be brooks and streams of
water on every lofty mountain and on
every high hill in the day of the great
slaughter, when the towers fall.
26 Moreover the light of the moon will
be like the light of the sun, and the light of
the sun will be seven times brighter, like
the light of seven days, in the day that
Yahweh binds up the fracture of his
people, and heals the wound they were
struck with.

27 Behold, Yahweh’s name comes from
far away, burning with his anger, and in
thick rising smoke. His lips are full of
indignation. His tongue is as a devouring
fire.
28 His breath is as an overflowing
stream that reaches even to the neck, to
sift the nations with the sieve of
destruction. A bridle that leads to ruin
will be in the jaws of the peoples.
29 You will have a song, as in the night
when a holy feast is kept, and gladness of
heart, as when one goes with a flute to
come to Yahweh’s mountain, to Israel’s
Rock.
30 Yahweh will cause his glorious voice
to be heard, and will show the descent of
his arm, with the indignation of his anger
and the flame of a devouring fire, with a
blast, storm, and hailstones.
31 For through Yahweh’s voice the
Assyrian will be dismayed. He will strike
him with his rod.
32 Every stroke of the rod of
punishment, which Yahweh will lay on
him, will be with the sound of
tambourines and harps. He will fight with
them in battles, brandishing weapons.

33 For his burning place has long been
ready. Yes, it is prepared for the king. He
has made its pyre deep and large with fire
and much wood. Yahweh’s breath, like a
stream of sulfur, kindles it.

31

1 Woe to those who go down to Egypt for
help,
and rely on horses,
and trust in chariots because they are
many,
and in horsemen because they are
very strong,
but they don’t look to the Holy One of
Israel,
and they don’t seek Yahweh!
2 Yet he also is wise, and will bring
disaster,
and will not call back his words, but
will arise against the house of the
evildoers,
and against the help of those who
work iniquity.
3 Now the Egyptians are men, and not God;
and their horses flesh, and not spirit.
When Yahweh stretches out his hand,
both he who helps shall stumble,
and he who is helped shall fall,
and they all shall be consumed
together.

4 For Yahweh says to me,
“As the lion and the young lion growling
over his prey,
if a multitude of shepherds is called
together against him,
will not be dismayed at their voice,
nor abase himself for their noise,
so Yahweh of Armies will come down
to fight on Mount Zion and on its
heights.
5 As birds hovering, so Yahweh of Armies
will protect Jerusalem.
He will protect and deliver it.
He will pass over and preserve it.”
6 Return to him from whom you have
deeply revolted, children of Israel.
7 For in that day everyone shall cast away
his idols of silver and his idols of gold—sin
which your own hands have made for
you.

8 “The Assyrian will fall by the sword,
not of man;
and the sword, not of mankind, shall
devour him.
He will flee from the sword,
and his young men will become
subject to forced labor.
9 His rock will pass away by reason of
terror,
and his princes will be afraid of the
banner,”
says Yahweh, whose fire is in Zion,
and his furnace in Jerusalem.

32

1 Behold, a king shall reign in
righteousness,
and princes shall rule in justice.
2 A man shall be as a hiding place from the
wind,
and a covert from the storm,
as streams of water in a dry place,
as the shade of a large rock in a weary
land.
3 The eyes of those who see will not be
dim,
and the ears of those who hear will
listen.
4 The heart of the rash will understand
knowledge,
and the tongue of the stammerers will
be ready to speak plainly.
5 The fool will no longer be called noble,
nor the scoundrel be highly
respected.
6 For the fool will speak folly,
and his heart will work iniquity,
to practice profanity,
and to utter error against Yahweh,
to make empty the soul of the hungry,
and to cause the drink of the thirsty to
fail.
7 The ways of the scoundrel are evil.
He devises wicked plans to destroy
the humble with lying words,
even when the needy speaks right.
8 But the noble devises noble things,
and he will continue in noble things.

9 Rise up, you women who are at ease!
Hear my voice!
You careless daughters, give ear to my
speech!
10 For days beyond a year you will be
troubled, you careless women;
for the vintage will fail.
The harvest won’t come.
11 Tremble, you women who are at ease!
Be troubled, you careless ones!
Strip yourselves, make yourselves
naked,
and put sackcloth on your waist.
12 Beat your breasts for the pleasant fields,
for the fruitful vine.
13 Thorns and briers will come up on my
people’s land;
yes, on all the houses of joy in the
joyous city.
14 For the palace will be forsaken.
The populous city will be deserted.
The hill and the watchtower will be
for dens forever,
a delight for wild donkeys,
a pasture of flocks,
15 until the Spirit is poured on us from on
high,
and the wilderness becomes a fruitful
field,
and the fruitful field is considered a
forest.

16 Then justice will dwell in the
wilderness;
and righteousness will remain in the
fruitful field.
17 The work of righteousness will be
peace,
and the effect of righteousness,
quietness and confidence forever.
18 My people will live in a peaceful
habitation,
in safe dwellings,
and in quiet resting places,
19 though hail flattens the forest,
and the city is leveled completely.
20 Blessed are you who sow beside all
waters,
who send out the feet of the ox and
the donkey.

33

1 Woe to you who destroy, but you weren’t
destroyed,

and who betray, but nobody betrayed you!
When you have finished destroying, you will be destroyed;
and when you have finished betrayal, you will be betrayed.

2 Yahweh, be gracious to us. We have waited for you.
Be our strength every morning,
our salvation also in the time of trouble.
3 At the noise of the thunder, the peoples have fled.
When you lift yourself up, the nations are scattered.
4 Your plunder will be gathered as the caterpillar gathers.
Men will leap on it as locusts leap.
5 Yahweh is exalted, for he dwells on high.
He has filled Zion with justice and righteousness.
6 There will be stability in your times,
abundance of salvation, wisdom, and knowledge.
The fear of Yahweh is your treasure.

7 Behold, their valiant ones cry outside;
the ambassadors of peace weep bitterly.
8 The highways are desolate.
The traveling man ceases.
The covenant is broken.
He has despised the cities.
He doesn't respect man.
9 The land mourns and languishes.
Lebanon is confounded and withers away.
Sharon is like a desert, and Bashan and Carmel are stripped bare.
10 "Now I will arise," says Yahweh.
"Now I will lift myself up.
Now I will be exalted.
11 You will conceive chaff.
You will give birth to stubble.
Your breath is a fire that will devour you.
12 The peoples will be like the burning of lime,
like thorns that are cut down and burned in the fire.
13 Hear, you who are far off, what I have done;
and, you who are near, acknowledge my might."
14 The sinners in Zion are afraid.
Trembling has seized the godless ones.
Who among us can live with the devouring fire?
Who among us can live with everlasting burning?
15 He who walks righteously
and speaks blamelessly,
he who despises the gain of oppressions,
who gestures with his hands, refusing to take a bribe,
who stops his ears from hearing of bloodshed,
and shuts his eyes from looking at evil—
16 he will dwell on high.
His place of defense will be the fortress of rocks.
His bread will be supplied.
His waters will be sure.

17 Your eyes will see the king in his beauty.
They will see a distant land.
18 Your heart will meditate on the terror.
Where is he who counted?
Where is he who weighed?
Where is he who counted the towers?
19 You will no longer see the fierce people,
a people of a deep speech that you can't comprehend,
with a strange language that you can't understand.
20 Look at Zion, the city of our appointed festivals.
Your eyes will see Jerusalem, a quiet habitation,
a tent that won't be removed.
Its stakes will never be plucked up,
nor will any of its cords be broken.
21 But there Yahweh will be with us in majesty,
a place of wide rivers and streams,
in which no galley with oars will go,
neither will any gallant ship pass by there.
22 For Yahweh is our judge.
Yahweh is our lawgiver.

Yahweh is our king.
He will save us.

23 Your rigging is untied.
They couldn't strengthen the foot of their mast.
They couldn't spread the sail.
Then the prey of a great plunder was divided.
The lame took the prey.

24 The inhabitant won't say, "I am sick."
The people who dwell therein will be forgiven their iniquity.

34

1 Come near, you nations, to hear!
Listen, you peoples.
Let the earth and all it contains hear,
the world, and everything that comes from it.
2 For Yahweh is enraged against all the nations,
and angry with all their armies.
He has utterly destroyed them.
He has given them over for slaughter.
3 Their slain will also be cast out,
and the stench of their dead bodies will come up.
The mountains will melt in their blood.
4 All of the army of the sky will be dissolved.
The sky will be rolled up like a scroll,
and all its armies will fade away,
as a leaf fades from off a vine or a fig tree.
5 For my sword has drunk its fill in the sky.
Behold, it will come down on Edom,
and on the people of my curse, for judgment.
6 Yahweh's sword is filled with blood.
It is covered with fat, with the blood of lambs and goats,
with the fat of the kidneys of rams;
for Yahweh has a sacrifice in Bozrah,
and a great slaughter in the land of Edom.
7 The wild oxen will come down with them,
and the young bulls with the mighty bulls;
and their land will be drunken with blood,
and their dust made greasy with fat.

8 For Yahweh has a day of vengeance,
a year of recompense for the cause of Zion.
9 Its streams will be turned into pitch,
its dust into sulfur,
and its land will become burning pitch.
10 It won't be quenched night or day.
Its smoke will go up forever.
From generation to generation, it will lie waste.
No one will pass through it forever and ever.
11 But the pelican and the porcupine will possess it.
The owl and the raven will dwell in it.
He will stretch the line of confusion over it,
and the plumb line of emptiness.
12 They shall call its nobles to the kingdom, but none shall be there;
and all its princes shall be nothing.
13 Thorns will come up in its palaces,
nettles and thistles in its fortresses;
and it will be a habitation of jackals,
a court for ostriches.
14 The wild animals of the desert will meet with the wolves,
and the wild goat will cry to his fellow.
Yes, the night creature† shall settle there,
and shall find herself a place of rest.
15 The arrow snake will make her nest there,
and lay, hatch, and gather under her shade.
Yes, the kites will be gathered there,
every one with her mate.

16 Search in the book of Yahweh, and read:
not one of these will be missing.
None will lack her mate.
For my mouth has commanded,
and his Spirit has gathered them.
17 He has cast the lot for them,
and his hand has divided it to them with a measuring line.
They shall possess it forever.

† **34:14** literally, lilith, which could also be a night demon or night monster

From generation to generation they
will dwell in it.

35

1 The wilderness and the dry land will be
glad.
The desert will rejoice and blossom
like a rose.
2 It will blossom abundantly,
and rejoice even with joy and singing.
Lebanon's glory will be given to it,
the excellence of Carmel and Sharon.
They will see Yahweh's glory,
the excellence of our God.

3 Strengthen the weak hands,
and make the feeble knees firm.
4 Tell those who have a fearful heart, "Be
strong!
Don't be afraid!
Behold, your God will come with
vengeance, God's retribution.
He will come and save you.

5 Then the eyes of the blind will be opened,
and the ears of the deaf will be
unstopped.
6 Then the lame man will leap like a deer,
and the tongue of the mute will sing;
for waters will break out in the
wilderness,
and streams in the desert.
7 The burning sand will become a pool,
and the thirsty ground springs of
water.
Grass with reeds and rushes will be in
the habitation of jackals, where
they lay.
8 A highway will be there, a road,
and it will be called "The Holy Way".
The unclean shall not pass over it,
but it will be for those who walk in
the Way.
Wicked fools shall not go there.
9 No lion will be there,
nor will any ravenous animal go up
on it.
They will not be found there;
but the redeemed will walk there.
10 Then Yahweh's ransomed ones will
return,
and come with singing to Zion;
and everlasting joy will be on their
heads.
They will obtain gladness and joy,
and sorrow and sighing will flee
away."

36

1 Now in the fourteenth year of King
Hezekiah, Sennacherib king of Assyria
attacked all of the fortified cities of Judah
and captured them.
2 The king of Assyria sent Rabshakeh
from Lachish to Jerusalem to King
Hezekiah with a large army. He stood by
the aqueduct from the upper pool in the
fuller's field highway.
3 Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who
was over the household, and Shebna the
scribe, and Joah, the son of Asaph the
recorder came out to him.
4 Rabshakeh said to them, "Now tell
Hezekiah, 'The great king, the king of
Assyria, says, "What confidence is this in
which you trust?
5 I say that your counsel and strength
for the war are only vain words. Now in
whom do you trust, that you have
rebelled against me?
6 Behold, you trust in the staff of this
bruised reed, even in Egypt, which if a
man leans on it, it will go into his hand
and pierce it. So is Pharaoh king of Egypt
to all who trust in him.
7 But if you tell me, 'We trust in Yahweh
our God,' isn't that he whose high places
and whose altars Hezekiah has taken
away, and has said to Judah and to
Jerusalem, 'You shall worship before this
altar'?"
8 Now therefore, please make a pledge
to my master the king of Assyria, and I will
give you two thousand horses, if you are
able on your part to set riders on them.
9 How then can you turn away the face
of one captain of the least of my master's
servants, and put your trust in Egypt for
chariots and for horsemen?
10 Have I come up now without Yahweh
against this land to destroy it? Yahweh
said to me, "Go up against this land, and
destroy it." ' "

11 Then Eliakim, Shebna and Joah said
to Rabshakeh, “Please speak to your
servants in Aramaic, for we understand it.
Don’t speak to us in the Jews’ language in
the hearing of the people who are on the
wall.”
12 But Rabshakeh said, “Has my master
sent me only to your master and to you, to
speak these words, and not to the men
who sit on the wall, who will eat their own
dung and drink their own urine with
you?”
13 Then Rabshakeh stood, and called out
with a loud voice in the Jews’ language,
and said, “Hear the words of the great
king, the king of Assyria!
14 The king says, ‘Don’t let Hezekiah
deceive you; for he will not be able to
deliver you.
15 Don’t let Hezekiah make you trust in
Yahweh, saying, “Yahweh will surely
deliver us. This city won’t be given into
the hand of the king of Assyria.” ’
16 Don’t listen to Hezekiah, for the king
of Assyria says, ‘Make your peace with
me, and come out to me; and each of you
eat from his vine, and each one from his
fig tree, and each one of you drink the
waters of his own cistern;
17 until I come and take you away to a
land like your own land, a land of grain
and new wine, a land of bread and
vineyards.
18 Beware lest Hezekiah persuade you,
saying, “Yahweh will deliver us.” Have
any of the gods of the nations delivered
their lands from the hand of the king of
Assyria?
19 Where are the gods of Hamath and
Arpad? Where are the gods of
Sepharvaim? Have they delivered
Samaria from my hand?
20 Who are they among all the gods of
these countries that have delivered their
country out of my hand, that Yahweh
should deliver Jerusalem out of my
hand?’ ”
21 But they remained silent, and said
nothing in reply, for the king’s
commandment was, “Don’t answer him.”
22 Then Eliakim the son of Hilkiah, who
was over the household, and Shebna the
scribe, and Joah, the son of Asaph the
recorder, came to Hezekiah with their
clothes torn, and told him the words of
Rabshakeh.

37

1 When King Hezekiah heard it, he tore
his clothes, covered himself with
sackcloth, and went into Yahweh’s house.
2 He sent Eliakim, who was over the
household, and Shebna the scribe, and the
elders of the priests, covered with
sackcloth, to Isaiah the prophet, the son of
Amoz.
3 They said to him, “Hezekiah says,
‘Today is a day of trouble, and of rebuke,
and of rejection; for the children have
come to the birth, and there is no strength
to give birth.
4 It may be Yahweh your God will hear
the words of Rabshakeh, whom the king
of Assyria his master has sent to defy the
living God, and will rebuke the words
which Yahweh your God has heard.
Therefore lift up your prayer for the
remnant that is left.’ ”
5 So the servants of King Hezekiah came
to Isaiah.
6 Isaiah said to them, “Tell your master,
‘Yahweh says, “Don’t be afraid of the
words that you have heard, with which
the servants of the king of Assyria have
blasphemed me.
7 Behold, I will put a spirit in him and he
will hear news, and will return to his own
land. I will cause him to fall by the sword
in his own land.” ’ ”
8 So Rabshakeh returned, and found the
king of Assyria warring against Libnah,
for he heard that he had departed from
Lachish.
9 He heard news concerning Tirhakah
king of Ethiopia, “He has come out to fight
against you.” When he heard it, he sent
messengers to Hezekiah, saying,
10 “Thus you shall speak to Hezekiah
king of Judah, saying, ‘Don’t let your God
in whom you trust deceive you, saying,
“Jerusalem won’t be given into the hand
of the king of Assyria.”

11 Behold, you have heard what the
kings of Assyria have done to all lands, by
destroying them utterly. Shall you be
delivered?
12 Have the gods of the nations
delivered them, which my fathers have
destroyed, Gozan, Haran, Rezeph, and the
children of Eden who were in Telassar?
13 Where is the king of Hamath, and the
king of Arpad, and the king of the city of
Sepharvaim, of Hena, and Ivvah?' "
14 Hezekiah received the letter from the
hand of the messengers and read it. Then
Hezekiah went up to Yahweh's house, and
spread it before Yahweh.
15 Hezekiah prayed to Yahweh, saying,
16 "Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel,
who is enthroned among the cherubim,
you are the God, even you alone, of all the
kingdoms of the earth. You have made
heaven and earth.
17 Turn your ear, Yahweh, and hear.
Open your eyes, Yahweh, and behold.
Hear all of the words of Sennacherib, who
has sent to defy the living God.
18 Truly, Yahweh, the kings of Assyria
have destroyed all the countries and their
land,
19 and have cast their gods into the fire;
for they were no gods, but the work of
men's hands, wood and stone; therefore
they have destroyed them.
20 Now therefore, Yahweh our God, save
us from his hand, that all the kingdoms of
the earth may know that you are Yahweh,
even you only."
21 Then Isaiah the son of Amoz sent to
Hezekiah, saying, "Yahweh, the God of
Israel says, 'Because you have prayed to
me against Sennacherib king of Assyria,
22 this is the word which Yahweh has
spoken concerning him: The virgin
daughter of Zion has despised you and
ridiculed you. The daughter of Jerusalem
has shaken her head at you.
23 Whom have you defied and
blasphemed? Against whom have you
exalted your voice and lifted up your eyes
on high? Against the Holy One of Israel.
24 By your servants, you have defied the
Lord, and have said, "With the multitude
of my chariots I have come up to the
height of the mountains, to the innermost
parts of Lebanon. I will cut down its tall
cedars and its choice cypress trees. I will
enter into its farthest height, the forest of
its fruitful field.
25 I have dug and drunk water, and with
the sole of my feet I will dry up all the
rivers of Egypt."

26 " 'Have you not heard how I have
done it long ago, and formed it in ancient
times? Now I have brought it to pass, that
it should be yours to destroy fortified
cities, turning them into ruinous heaps.
27 Therefore their inhabitants had little
power. They were dismayed and
confounded. They were like the grass of
the field, and like the green herb, like the
grass on the housetops, and like a field
before its crop has grown.
28 But I know your sitting down, your
going out, your coming in, and your
raging against me.
29 Because of your raging against me,
and because your arrogance has come up
into my ears, therefore I will put my hook
in your nose and my bridle in your lips,
and I will turn you back by the way by
which you came.

30 " 'This shall be the sign to you: You
will eat this year that which grows of
itself, and in the second year that which
springs from it; and in the third year sow
and reap and plant vineyards, and eat
their fruit.
31 The remnant that is escaped of the
house of Judah will again take root
downward, and bear fruit upward.
32 For out of Jerusalem a remnant will
go out, and survivors will escape from
Mount Zion. The zeal of Yahweh of
Armies will perform this.'

33 "Therefore Yahweh says concerning
the king of Assyria, 'He will not come to
this city, nor shoot an arrow there,
neither will he come before it with shield,
nor cast up a mound against it.
34 He will return the way that he came,
and he won't come to this city,' says
Yahweh.

35 ‘For I will defend this city to save it,
for my own sake, and for my servant
David’s sake.’ ”
36 Then Yahweh’s angel went out and
struck one hundred and eighty-five
thousand men in the camp of the
Assyrians. When men arose early in the
morning, behold, these were all dead
bodies.
37 So Sennacherib king of Assyria
departed, went away, returned to
Nineveh, and stayed there.
38 As he was worshiping in the house of
Nisroch his god, Adrammelech and
Sharezer his sons struck him with the
sword; and they escaped into the land of
Ararat. Esar Haddon his son reigned in
his place.

38

1 In those days Hezekiah was sick and
near death. Isaiah the prophet, the son of
Amoz, came to him, and said to him,
“Yahweh says, ‘Set your house in order,
for you will die, and not live.’ ”
2 Then Hezekiah turned his face to the
wall and prayed to Yahweh,
3 and said, “Remember now, Yahweh, I
beg you, how I have walked before you in
truth and with a perfect heart, and have
done that which is good in your sight.”
Then Hezekiah wept bitterly.
4 Then Yahweh’s word came to Isaiah,
saying,
5 “Go, and tell Hezekiah, ‘Yahweh, the
God of David your father, says, “I have
heard your prayer. I have seen your tears.
Behold, I will add fifteen years to your life.
6 I will deliver you and this city out of
the hand of the king of Assyria, and I will
defend this city.
7 This shall be the sign to you from
Yahweh, that Yahweh will do this thing
that he has spoken.
8 Behold, I will cause the shadow on the
sundial, which has gone down on the
sundial of Ahaz with the sun, to return
backward ten steps.” ’ ” So the sun
returned ten steps on the sundial on
which it had gone down.

9 The writing of Hezekiah king of Judah,
when he had been sick, and had
recovered of his sickness:
10 I said, “In the middle of my life I go into
the gates of Sheol.†
I am deprived of the residue of my
years.”
11 I said, “I won’t see Yah,
Yah in the land of the living.
I will see man no more with the
inhabitants of the world.
12 My dwelling is removed,
and is carried away from me like a
shepherd’s tent.
I have rolled up my life like a weaver.
He will cut me off from the loom.
From day even to night you will make
an end of me.
13 I waited patiently until morning.
He breaks all my bones like a lion.
From day even to night you will make
an end of me.
14 I chattered like a swallow or a crane.
I moaned like a dove.
My eyes weaken looking upward.
Lord, I am oppressed.
Be my security.”
15 What will I say?
He has both spoken to me, and
himself has done it.
I will walk carefully all my years
because of the anguish of my soul.
16 Lord, men live by these things;
and my spirit finds life in all of them.
You restore me, and cause me to live.
17 Behold, for peace I had great anguish,
but you have in love for my soul
delivered it from the pit of
corruption;
for you have cast all my sins behind
your back.
18 For Sheol‡ can’t praise you.
Death can’t celebrate you.
Those who go down into the pit can’t hope
for your truth.
19 The living, the living, he shall praise
you, as I do today.
The father shall make known your
truth to the children.
20 Yahweh will save me.

† **38:10** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **38:18** Sheol is the place of the dead.

Therefore we will sing my songs with
stringed instruments all the days of
our life in Yahweh's house.
21 Now Isaiah had said, "Let them take a
cake of figs, and lay it for a poultice on the
boil, and he shall recover."
22 Hezekiah also had said, "What is the
sign that I will go up to Yahweh's house?"

39

1 At that time, Merodach-baladan the
son of Baladan, king of Babylon, sent
letters and a present to Hezekiah, for he
heard that he had been sick, and had
recovered.
2 Hezekiah was pleased with them, and
showed them the house of his precious
things, the silver, the gold, the spices, and
the precious oil, and all the house of his
armor, and all that was found in his
treasures. There was nothing in his
house, nor in all his dominion, that
Hezekiah didn't show them.
3 Then Isaiah the prophet came to King
Hezekiah, and asked him, "What did these
men say? From where did they come to
you?"

Hezekiah said, "They have come from a
country far from me, even from Babylon."

4 Then he asked, "What have they seen
in your house?"

Hezekiah answered, "They have seen
all that is in my house. There is nothing
among my treasures that I have not
shown them."
5 Then Isaiah said to Hezekiah, "Hear
the word of Yahweh of Armies:
6 'Behold, the days are coming when all
that is in your house, and that which your
fathers have stored up until today, will be
carried to Babylon. Nothing will be left,'
says Yahweh.
7 'They will take away your sons who
will issue from you, whom you shall
father, and they will be eunuchs in the
king of Babylon's palace.' "

8 Then Hezekiah said to Isaiah,
"Yahweh's word which you have spoken
is good." He said moreover, "For there
will be peace and truth in my days."

40

1 "Comfort, comfort my people," says
your God.
2 "Speak comfortably to Jerusalem, and
call out to her that her warfare is
accomplished, that her iniquity is
pardoned, that she has received of
Yahweh's hand double for all her sins."
3 The voice of one who calls out,
"Prepare the way of Yahweh in the
wilderness!
Make a level highway in the desert for
our God.
4 Every valley shall be exalted,
and every mountain and hill shall be
made low.
The uneven shall be made level,
and the rough places a plain.
5 Yahweh's glory shall be revealed,
and all flesh shall see it together;
for the mouth of Yahweh has spoken
it."

6 The voice of one saying, "Cry out!"
One said, "What shall I cry?"
"All flesh is like grass,
and all its glory is like the flower of
the field.
7 The grass withers,
the flower fades,
because Yahweh's breath blows on it.
Surely the people are like grass.
8 The grass withers,
the flower fades;
but the word of our God stands
forever."

9 You who tell good news to Zion, go up on
a high mountain.
You who tell good news to Jerusalem,
lift up your voice with strength!
Lift it up! Don't be afraid!
Say to the cities of Judah, "Behold,
your God!"
10 Behold, the Lord Yahweh will come as a
mighty one,
and his arm will rule for him.
Behold, his reward is with him,
and his recompense before him.
11 He will feed his flock like a shepherd.
He will gather the lambs in his arm,
and carry them in his bosom.

He will gently lead those who have
their young.

12 Who has measured the waters in the
hollow of his hand,
and marked off the sky with his span,
and calculated the dust of the earth in
a measuring basket,
and weighed the mountains in scales,
and the hills in a balance?
13 Who has directed Yahweh's Spirit,
or has taught him as his counselor?
14 Who did he take counsel with,
and who instructed him,
and taught him in the path of justice,
and taught him knowledge,
and showed him the way of
understanding?
15 Behold, the nations are like a drop in a
bucket,
and are regarded as a speck of dust on
a balance.
Behold, he lifts up the islands like a
very little thing.
16 Lebanon is not sufficient to burn,
nor its animals sufficient for a burnt
offering.
17 All the nations are like nothing before
him.
They are regarded by him as less than
nothing, and vanity.

18 To whom then will you liken God?
Or what likeness will you compare to
him?
19 A workman has cast an image,
and the goldsmith overlays it with
gold,
and casts silver chains for it.
20 He who is too impoverished for such an
offering chooses a tree that will not
rot.
He seeks a skillful workman to set up
a carved image for him that will not
be moved.

21 Haven't you known?
Haven't you heard?
Haven't you been told from the
beginning?
Haven't you understood from the
foundations of the earth?
22 It is he who sits above the circle of the
earth,
and its inhabitants are like
grasshoppers;
who stretches out the heavens like a
curtain,
and spreads them out like a tent to
dwell in,
23 who brings princes to nothing,
who makes the judges of the earth
meaningless.
24 They are planted scarcely.
They are sown scarcely.
Their stock has scarcely taken root in
the ground.
He merely blows on them, and they
wither,
and the whirlwind takes them away
as stubble.

25 "To whom then will you liken me?
Who is my equal?" says the Holy One.
26 Lift up your eyes on high,
and see who has created these,
who brings out their army by
number.
He calls them all by name.
By the greatness of his might,
and because he is strong in power,
not one is lacking.

27 Why do you say, Jacob,
and speak, Israel,
"My way is hidden from Yahweh,
and the justice due me is disregarded
by my God"?
28 Haven't you known?
Haven't you heard?
The everlasting God, Yahweh,
the Creator of the ends of the earth,
doesn't faint.
He isn't weary.
His understanding is unsearchable.
29 He gives power to the weak.
He increases the strength of him who
has no might.
30 Even the youths faint and get weary,
and the young men utterly fall;
31 but those who wait for Yahweh will
renew their strength.
They will mount up with wings like
eagles.

They will run, and not be weary.
They will walk, and not faint.

41

1 "Keep silent before me, islands,
and let the peoples renew their strength.
Let them come near,
then let them speak.
Let's meet together for judgment.
2 Who has raised up one from the east?
Who called him to his feet in righteousness?
He hands over nations to him
and makes him rule over kings.
He gives them like the dust to his sword,
like the driven stubble to his bow.
3 He pursues them
and passes by safely,
even by a way that he had not gone with his feet.
4 Who has worked and done it,
calling the generations from the beginning?
I, Yahweh, the first, and with the last, I am he."

5 The islands have seen, and fear.
The ends of the earth tremble.
They approach, and come.
6 Everyone helps his neighbor.
They say to their brothers, "Be strong!"
7 So the carpenter encourages the goldsmith.
He who smooths with the hammer encourages him who strikes the anvil,
saying of the soldering, "It is good;"
and he fastens it with nails, that it might not totter.

8 "But you, Israel, my servant,
Jacob whom I have chosen,
the offspring of Abraham my friend,
9 you whom I have taken hold of from the ends of the earth,
and called from its corners,
and said to you, 'You are my servant. I have chosen you and have not cast you away.'
10 Don't you be afraid, for I am with you.
Don't be dismayed, for I am your God.
I will strengthen you.
Yes, I will help you.
Yes, I will uphold you with the right hand of my righteousness.
11 Behold, all those who are incensed against you will be disappointed and confounded.
Those who strive with you will be like nothing, and shall perish.
12 You will seek them, and won't find them,
even those who contend with you.
Those who war against you will be as nothing,
as a nonexistent thing.
13 For I, Yahweh your God, will hold your right hand,
saying to you, 'Don't be afraid.
I will help you.'
14 Don't be afraid, you worm Jacob,
and you men of Israel.
I will help you," says Yahweh.
"Your Redeemer is the Holy One of Israel.
15 Behold, I have made you into a new sharp threshing instrument with teeth.
You will thresh the mountains,
and beat them small,
and will make the hills like chaff.
16 You will winnow them,
and the wind will carry them away,
and the whirlwind will scatter them.
You will rejoice in Yahweh.
You will glory in the Holy One of Israel.

17 The poor and needy seek water, and there is none.
Their tongue fails for thirst.
I, Yahweh, will answer them.
I, the God of Israel, will not forsake them.
18 I will open rivers on the bare heights,
and springs in the middle of the valleys.
I will make the wilderness a pool of water,
and the dry land springs of water.
19 I will put cedar, acacia, myrtle, and oil trees in the wilderness.
I will set cypress trees, pine, and box trees together in the desert;

20 that they may see, know, consider,
and understand together,
that Yahweh's hand has done this,
and the Holy One of Israel has created
it.

21 Produce your cause," says Yahweh.
"Bring out your strong reasons!" says
the King of Jacob.
22 "Let them announce and declare to us
what will happen!
Declare the former things, what they
are,
that we may consider them, and
know the latter end of them;
or show us things to come.
23 Declare the things that are to come
hereafter,
that we may know that you are gods.
Yes, do good, or do evil,
that we may be dismayed,
and see it together.
24 Behold, you are nothing,
and your work is nothing.
He who chooses you is an
abomination.

25 "I have raised up one from the north,
and he has come,
from the rising of the sun, one who
calls on my name,
and he shall come on rulers as on
mortar,
and as the potter treads clay.
26 Who has declared it from the
beginning, that we may know?
and before, that we may say, 'He is
right'?
Surely, there is no one who declares.
Surely, there is no one who shows.
Surely, there is no one who hears
your words.
27 I am the first to say to Zion, 'Behold, look
at them;'
and I will give one who brings good
news to Jerusalem.
28 When I look, there is no man,
even among them there is no
counselor who, when I ask, can
answer a word.
29 Behold, all of their deeds are vanity and
nothing.
Their molten images are wind and
confusion.

42

1 "Behold, my servant, whom I uphold,
my chosen, in whom my soul delights:
I have put my Spirit on him.
He will bring justice to the nations.
2 He will not shout,
nor raise his voice,
nor cause it to be heard in the street.
3 He won't break a bruised reed.
He won't quench a dimly burning
wick.
He will faithfully bring justice.
4 He will not fail nor be discouraged,
until he has set justice in the earth,
and the islands wait for his law."

5 God Yahweh,
he who created the heavens and
stretched them out,
he who spread out the earth and that
which comes out of it,
he who gives breath to its people and
spirit to those who walk in it, says:
6 "I, Yahweh, have called you in
righteousness.
I will hold your hand.
I will keep you,
and make you a covenant for the
people,
as a light for the nations,
7 to open the blind eyes,
to bring the prisoners out of the
dungeon,
and those who sit in darkness out of
the prison.

8 "I am Yahweh.
That is my name.
I will not give my glory to another,
nor my praise to engraved images.
9 Behold, the former things have
happened
and I declare new things.
I tell you about them before they
come up."

10 Sing to Yahweh a new song,
and his praise from the end of the
earth,
you who go down to the sea,

and all that is therein,
the islands and their inhabitants.
11 Let the wilderness and its cities raise their voices,
with the villages that Kedar inhabits.
Let the inhabitants of Sela sing.
Let them shout from the top of the mountains!
12 Let them give glory to Yahweh,
and declare his praise in the islands.
13 Yahweh will go out like a mighty man.
He will stir up zeal like a man of war.
He will raise a war cry.
Yes, he will shout aloud.
He will triumph over his enemies.

14 "I have been silent a long time.
I have been quiet and restrained myself.
Now I will cry out like a travailing woman. I will both gasp and pant.
15 I will destroy mountains and hills,
and dry up all their herbs.
I will make the rivers islands,
and will dry up the pools.
16 I will bring the blind by a way that they don't know.
I will lead them in paths that they don't know.
I will make darkness light before them,
and crooked places straight.
I will do these things,
and I will not forsake them.

17 "Those who trust in engraved images,
who tell molten images,
'You are our gods,'
will be turned back.
They will be utterly disappointed.

18 "Hear, you deaf,
and look, you blind,
that you may see.
19 Who is blind, but my servant?
Or who is as deaf as my messenger whom I send?
Who is as blind as he who is at peace,
and as blind as Yahweh's servant?
20 You see many things, but don't observe.
His ears are open, but he doesn't listen.
21 It pleased Yahweh, for his righteousness' sake, to magnify the law
and make it honorable.
22 But this is a robbed and plundered people.
All of them are snared in holes,
and they are hidden in prisons.
They have become captives, and no one delivers,
and a plunder, and no one says,
'Restore them!'

23 Who is there among you who will give ear to this?
Who will listen and hear for the time to come?
24 Who gave Jacob as plunder,
and Israel to the robbers?
Didn't Yahweh, he against whom we have sinned?
For they would not walk in his ways,
and they disobeyed his law.
25 Therefore he poured the fierceness of his anger on him,
and the strength of battle.
It set him on fire all around, but he didn't know.
It burned him, but he didn't take it to heart."

43

1 But now Yahweh who created you, Jacob,
and he who formed you, Israel, says:
"Don't be afraid, for I have redeemed you.
I have called you by your name.
You are mine.
2 When you pass through the waters, I will be with you,
and through the rivers, they will not overflow you.
When you walk through the fire, you will not be burned,
and flame will not scorch you.
3 For I am Yahweh your God,
the Holy One of Israel,
your Savior.
I have given Egypt as your ransom,
Ethiopia and Seba in your place.
4 Since you have been precious and honored in my sight,
and I have loved you,

therefore I will give people in your
place,
and nations instead of your life.
5 Don't be afraid, for I am with you.
I will bring your offspring from the
east,
and gather you from the west.
6 I will tell the north, 'Give them up!'
and tell the south, 'Don't hold them
back!
Bring my sons from far away,
and my daughters from the ends of
the earth—
7 everyone who is called by my name,
and whom I have created for my
glory,
whom I have formed,
yes, whom I have made.' "

8 Bring out the blind people who have
eyes,
and the deaf who have ears.
9 Let all the nations be gathered together,
and let the peoples be assembled.
Who among them can declare this,
and show us former things?
Let them bring their witnesses, that they
may be justified,
or let them hear, and say, "That is
true."

10 "You are my witnesses," says Yahweh,
"With my servant whom I have
chosen;
that you may know and believe me,
and understand that I am he.
Before me there was no God formed,
neither will there be after me.
11 I myself am Yahweh.
Besides me, there is no savior.
12 I have declared, I have saved, and I
have shown,
and there was no strange god among
you.
Therefore you are my witnesses",
says Yahweh, "and I am God.
13 Yes, since the day was, I am he.
There is no one who can deliver out of
my hand.
I will work, and who can hinder it?"
14 Yahweh, your Redeemer, the Holy
One of Israel says: "For your sake, I have
sent to Babylon, and I will bring all of
them down as fugitives, even the
Chaldeans, in the ships of their rejoicing.
15 I am Yahweh, your Holy One, the
Creator of Israel, your King."
16 Yahweh, who makes a way in the sea,
and a path in the mighty waters,
17 who brings out the chariot and horse,
the army and the mighty man
(they lie down together, they shall not
rise;
they are extinct, they are quenched
like a wick) says:
18 "Don't remember the former things,
and don't consider the things of old.
19 Behold, I will do a new thing.
It springs out now.
Don't you know it?
I will even make a way in the wilderness,
and rivers in the desert.
20 The animals of the field, the jackals and
the ostriches, shall honor me,
because I give water in the
wilderness and rivers in the desert,
to give drink to my people, my chosen,
21 the people which I formed for
myself,
that they might declare my praise.

22 Yet you have not called on me, Jacob;
but you have been weary of me,
Israel.
23 You have not brought me any of your
sheep for burnt offerings,
neither have you honored me with
your sacrifices.
I have not burdened you with offerings,
nor wearied you with frankincense.
24 You have bought me no sweet cane with
money,
nor have you filled me with the fat of
your sacrifices,
but you have burdened me with your sins.
You have wearied me with your
iniquities.

25 I, even I, am he who blots out your
transgressions for my own sake;
and I will not remember your sins.
26 Put me in remembrance.
Let us plead together.
Declare your case,

that you may be justified.
27 Your first father sinned,
and your teachers have transgressed against me.
28 Therefore I will profane the princes of the sanctuary;
and I will make Jacob a curse,
and Israel an insult."

44

1 Yet listen now, Jacob my servant,
and Israel, whom I have chosen.
2 This is what Yahweh who made you,
and formed you from the womb,
who will help you says:
"Don't be afraid, Jacob my servant;
and you, Jeshurun, whom I have chosen.
3 For I will pour water on him who is thirsty,
and streams on the dry ground.
I will pour my Spirit on your descendants,
and my blessing on your offspring;
4 and they will spring up among the grass,
as willows by the watercourses.
5 One will say, 'I am Yahweh's.'
Another will be called by the name of Jacob;
and another will write with his hand 'to Yahweh,'
and honor the name of Israel."

6 This is what Yahweh, the King of Israel,
and his Redeemer, Yahweh of Armies, says:
"I am the first, and I am the last;
and besides me there is no God.
7 Who is like me?
Who will call,
and will declare it,
and set it in order for me,
since I established the ancient people?
Let them declare the things that are coming,
and that will happen.
8 Don't fear,
neither be afraid.
Haven't I declared it to you long ago,
and shown it?
You are my witnesses.
Is there a God besides me?
Indeed, there is not.
I don't know any other Rock."

9 Everyone who makes a carved image is vain.
The things that they delight in will not profit.
Their own witnesses don't see, nor know, that they may be disappointed.
10 Who has fashioned a god,
or molds an image that is profitable for nothing?
11 Behold, all his fellows will be disappointed;
and the workmen are mere men.
Let them all be gathered together.
Let them stand up.
They will fear.
They will be put to shame together.

12 The blacksmith takes an ax,
works in the coals,
fashions it with hammers,
and works it with his strong arm.
He is hungry,
and his strength fails;
he drinks no water,
and is faint.
13 The carpenter stretches out a line.
He marks it out with a pencil.
He shapes it with planes.
He marks it out with compasses,
and shapes it like the figure of a man,
with the beauty of a man,
to reside in a house.
14 He cuts down cedars for himself,
and takes the cypress and the oak,
and strengthens for himself one among the trees of the forest.
He plants a cypress tree,
and the rain nourishes it.
15 Then it will be for a man to burn;
and he takes some of it and warms himself.
Yes, he burns it and bakes bread.
Yes, he makes a god and worships it;
he makes it a carved image, and falls down to it.
16 He burns part of it in the fire.
With part of it, he eats meat.
He roasts a roast and is satisfied.
Yes, he warms himself

and says, “Aha! I am warm. I have
seen the fire.”
17 The rest of it he makes into a god,
even his engraved image.
He bows down to it and worships,
and prays to it, and says, “Deliver me,
for you are my god!”

18 They don’t know, neither do they
consider,
for he has shut their eyes, that they
can’t see,
and their hearts, that they can’t
understand.
19 No one thinks,
neither is there knowledge nor
understanding to say,
“I have burned part of it in the fire.
Yes, I have also baked bread on its
coals.
I have roasted meat and eaten it.
Shall I make the rest of it into an
abomination?
Shall I bow down to a tree trunk?”
20 He feeds on ashes.
A deceived heart has turned him
aside;
and he can’t deliver his soul,
nor say, “Isn’t there a lie in my right
hand?”

21 Remember these things, Jacob and
Israel,
for you are my servant.
I have formed you.
You are my servant.
Israel, you will not be forgotten by
me.
22 I have blotted out, as a thick cloud, your
transgressions,
and, as a cloud, your sins.
Return to me, for I have redeemed
you.

23 Sing, you heavens, for Yahweh has done
it!
Shout, you lower parts of the earth!
Break out into singing, you
mountains, O forest, all of your
trees,
for Yahweh has redeemed Jacob,
and will glorify himself in Israel.

24 Yahweh, your Redeemer,
and he who formed you from the
womb says:
“I am Yahweh, who makes all things;
who alone stretches out the heavens;
who spreads out the earth by myself;
25 who frustrates the signs of the liars,
and makes diviners mad;
who turns wise men backward,
and makes their knowledge foolish;
26 who confirms the word of his servant,
and performs the counsel of his
messengers;
who says of Jerusalem, ‘She will be
inhabited;’
and of the cities of Judah, ‘They will
be built,’
and ‘I will raise up its waste places;’
27 who says to the deep, ‘Be dry,’
and ‘I will dry up your rivers,’
28 who says of Cyrus, ‘He is my shepherd,
and shall perform all my pleasure,’
even saying of Jerusalem, ‘She will be
built;’
and of the temple, ‘Your foundation
will be laid.’ ”

45

1 Yahweh says to his anointed, to Cyrus,
whose right hand I have held to subdue
nations before him and strip kings of their
armor, to open the doors before him, and
the gates shall not be shut:
2 “I will go before you
and make the rough places smooth.
I will break the doors of bronze in pieces
and cut apart the bars of iron.
3 I will give you the treasures of darkness
and hidden riches of secret places,
that you may know that it is I, Yahweh,
who calls you by your name,
even the God of Israel.
4 For Jacob my servant’s sake,
and Israel my chosen,
I have called you by your name.
I have given you a title,
though you have not known me.
5 I am Yahweh, and there is no one else.
Besides me, there is no God.
I will strengthen† you,
though you have not known me,

† **45:5** or, equip

6 that they may know from the rising of the sun,
and from the west,
that there is no one besides me.
I am Yahweh, and there is no one else.
7 I form the light
and create darkness.
I make peace
and create calamity.
I am Yahweh,
who does all these things.

8 Rain, you heavens, from above,
and let the skies pour down righteousness.
Let the earth open, that it may produce salvation,
and let it cause righteousness to spring up with it.
I, Yahweh, have created it.

9 Woe to him who strives with his Maker—
a clay pot among the clay pots of the earth!
Shall the clay ask him who fashions it,
'What are you making?'
or your work, 'He has no hands'?
10 Woe to him who says to a father, 'What have you become the father of?'
or to a mother, 'What have you given birth to?' "

11 Yahweh, the Holy One of Israel
and his Maker says:
"You ask me about the things that are to come, concerning my sons,
and you command me concerning the work of my hands!
12 I have made the earth, and created man on it.
I, even my hands, have stretched out the heavens.
I have commanded all their army.
13 I have raised him up in righteousness,
and I will make all his ways straight.
He shall build my city,
and he shall let my exiles go free,
not for price nor reward," says Yahweh of Armies.

14 Yahweh says: "The labor of Egypt,
and the merchandise of Ethiopia,
and the Sabeans, men of stature, will come over to you,
and they will be yours.
They will go after you.
They shall come over in chains.
They will bow down to you.
They will make supplication to you:
'Surely God is in you; and there is no one else.
There is no other god.
15 Most certainly you are a God who has hidden yourself,
God of Israel, the Savior.' "
16 They will be disappointed,
yes, confounded, all of them.
Those who are makers of idols will go into confusion together.
17 Israel will be saved by Yahweh with an everlasting salvation.
You will not be disappointed nor confounded to ages everlasting.

18 For Yahweh who created the heavens,
the God who formed the earth and made it,
who established it and didn't create it a waste,
who formed it to be inhabited says:
"I am Yahweh.
There is no other.
19 I have not spoken in secret,
in a place of the land of darkness.
I didn't say to the offspring of Jacob, 'Seek me in vain.'
I, Yahweh, speak righteousness.
I declare things that are right.

20 "Assemble yourselves and come.
Draw near together, you who have escaped from the nations.
Those have no knowledge who carry the wood of their engraved image,
and pray to a god that can't save.
21 Declare and present it.
Yes, let them take counsel together.
Who has shown this from ancient time?
Who has declared it of old?
Haven't I, Yahweh?
There is no other God besides me, a just God and a Savior.
There is no one besides me.

22 “Look to me, and be saved, all the ends
of the earth;
for I am God, and there is no other.
23 I have sworn by myself.
The word has gone out of my mouth
in righteousness, and will not be
revoked,
that to me every knee shall bow,
every tongue shall take an oath.
24 They will say of me,
‘There is righteousness and strength
only in Yahweh.’ ”
Even to him will men come.
All those who raged against him will
be disappointed.
25 All the offspring of Israel will be
justified in Yahweh,
and will rejoice!

46

1 Bel bows down.
Nebo stoops.
Their idols are carried by animals,
and on the livestock.
The things that you carried around are
heavy loads,
a burden for the weary.
2 They stoop and they bow down together.
They could not deliver the burden,
but they have gone into captivity.

3 “Listen to me, house of Jacob,
and all the remnant of the house of
Israel,
that have been carried from their
birth,
that have been carried from the
womb.
4 Even to old age I am he,
and even to gray hairs I will carry
you.
I have made, and I will bear.
Yes, I will carry, and will deliver.

5 “To whom will you compare me, and
consider my equal,
and compare me, as if we were the
same?
6 Some pour out gold from the bag,
and weigh silver in the balance.
They hire a goldsmith,
and he makes it a god.
They fall down—
yes, they worship.
7 They bear it on their shoulder.
They carry it, and set it in its place,
and it stands there.
It cannot move from its place.
Yes, one may cry to it, yet it can not
answer.
It cannot save him out of his trouble.

8 “Remember this, and show yourselves
men.
Bring it to mind again, you
transgressors.
9 Remember the former things of old;
for I am God, and there is no other.
I am God, and there is none like me.
10 I declare the end from the beginning,
and from ancient times things that
are not yet done.
I say: My counsel will stand,
and I will do all that I please.
11 I call a ravenous bird from the east,
the man of my counsel from a far
country.
Yes, I have spoken.
I will also bring it to pass.
I have planned.
I will also do it.

12 Listen to me, you stubborn-hearted,
who are far from righteousness!
13 I bring my righteousness near.
It is not far off,
and my salvation will not wait.
I will grant salvation to Zion,
my glory to Israel.

47

1 “Come down and sit in the dust, virgin
daughter of Babylon.
Sit on the ground without a throne,
daughter of the Chaldeans.
For you will no longer be called
tender and delicate.
2 Take the millstones and grind flour.
Remove your veil, lift up your skirt,
uncover your legs,
and wade through the rivers.
3 Your nakedness will be uncovered.
Yes, your shame will be seen.
I will take vengeance,
and will spare no one.”

4 Our Redeemer, Yahweh of Armies is his name,
the Holy One of Israel.

5 "Sit in silence, and go into darkness,
daughter of the Chaldeans.
For you shall no longer be called
the mistress of kingdoms.
6 I was angry with my people.
I profaned my inheritance
and gave them into your hand.
You showed them no mercy.
You laid a very heavy yoke on the aged.
7 You said, 'I will be a princess forever,'
so that you didn't lay these things to your heart,
nor did you remember the results.

8 "Now therefore hear this, you who are given to pleasures,
who sit securely,
who say in your heart,
'I am, and there is no one else besides me.
I won't sit as a widow,
neither will I know the loss of children.'
9 But these two things will come to you in a moment in one day:
the loss of children and widowhood.
They will come on you in their full measure,
in the multitude of your sorceries,
and the great abundance of your enchantments.
10 For you have trusted in your wickedness.
You have said, 'No one sees me.'
Your wisdom and your knowledge has perverted you.
You have said in your heart, 'I am, and there is no one else besides me.'
11 Therefore disaster will come on you.
You won't know when it dawns.
Mischief will fall on you.
You won't be able to put it away.
Desolation will come on you suddenly,
which you don't understand.

12 "Stand now with your enchantments
and with the multitude of your sorceries,
in which you have labored from your youth,
as if you might profit,
as if you might prevail.
13 You are wearied in the multitude of your counsels.
Now let the astrologers, the stargazers, and the monthly prognosticators stand up and save you from the things that will happen to you.
14 Behold, they are like stubble.
The fire will burn them.
They won't deliver themselves from the power of the flame.
It won't be a coal to warm at
or a fire to sit by.
15 The things that you labored in will be like this:
those who have trafficked with you from your youth will each wander in his own way.
There will be no one to save you.

48

1 "Hear this, house of Jacob,
you who are called by the name of Israel,
and have come out of the waters of Judah.
You swear by Yahweh's name,
and make mention of the God of Israel,
but not in truth, nor in righteousness—
2 for they call themselves citizens of the holy city,
and rely on the God of Israel;
Yahweh of Armies is his name.
3 I have declared the former things from of old.
Yes, they went out of my mouth, and I revealed them.
I did them suddenly, and they happened.
4 Because I knew that you are obstinate,
and your neck is an iron sinew,
and your brow bronze;
5 therefore I have declared it to you from of old;
before it came to pass I showed it to you;

lest you should say, ‘My idol has done
them.
My engraved image and my molten
image has commanded them.’
6 You have heard it.
Now see all this.
And you, won’t you declare it?

“I have shown you new things from this
time,
even hidden things, which you have
not known.
7 They are created now, and not from of
old.
Before today, you didn’t hear them,
lest you should say, ‘Behold, I knew
them.’
8 Yes, you didn’t hear.
Yes, you didn’t know.
Yes, from of old your ear was not
opened,
for I knew that you dealt very
treacherously,
and were called a transgressor from
the womb.
9 For my name’s sake, I will defer my
anger,
and for my praise, I hold it back for
you
so that I don’t cut you off.
10 Behold, I have refined you,
but not as silver.
I have chosen you in the furnace of
affliction.
11 For my own sake,
for my own sake, I will do it;
for how would my name be profaned?
I will not give my glory to another.

12 “Listen to me, O Jacob,
and Israel my called:
I am he.
I am the first.
I am also the last.
13 Yes, my hand has laid the foundation of
the earth,
and my right hand has spread out the
heavens.
when I call to them, they stand up
together.

14 “Assemble yourselves, all of you, and
hear!
Who among them has declared these
things?
He whom Yahweh loves will do what he
likes to Babylon,
and his arm will be against the
Chaldeans.
15 I, even I, have spoken.
Yes, I have called him.
I have brought him
and he shall make his way
prosperous.
16 “Come near to me and hear this:

“From the beginning I have not spoken in
secret;
from the time that it happened, I was
there.”

Now the Lord Yahweh has sent me
with his Spirit.

17 Yahweh,
your Redeemer,
the Holy One of Israel, says:
“I am Yahweh your God,
who teaches you to profit,
who leads you by the way that you
should go.
18 Oh that you had listened to my
commandments!
Then your peace would have been
like a river
and your righteousness like the
waves of the sea.
19 Your offspring also would have been as
the sand
and the descendants of your body like
its grains.
His name would not be cut off nor
destroyed from before me.”

20 Leave Babylon!
Flee from the Chaldeans!
With the sound of joyful shouting
announce this,
tell it even to the end of the earth;
say, “Yahweh has redeemed his
servant Jacob!”
21 They didn’t thirst when he led them
through the deserts.
He caused the waters to flow out of
the rock for them.
He also split the rock and the waters
gushed out.

22 “There is no peace”, says Yahweh, “for
the wicked.”

49

1 Listen, islands, to me.
Listen, you peoples, from afar:
Yahweh has called me from the womb;
from the inside of my mother, he has
mentioned my name.
2 He has made my mouth like a sharp
sword.
He has hidden me in the shadow of
his hand.
He has made me a polished shaft.
He has kept me close in his quiver.
3 He said to me, “You are my servant,
Israel, in whom I will be glorified.”
4 But I said, “I have labored in vain.
I have spent my strength in vain for
nothing;
yet surely the justice due to me is with
Yahweh,
and my reward with my God.”

5 Now Yahweh, he who formed me from
the womb to be his servant,
says to bring Jacob again to him,
and to gather Israel to him,
for I am honorable in Yahweh’s eyes,
and my God has become my strength.
6 Indeed, he says, “It is too light a thing
that you should be my servant to
raise up the tribes of Jacob,
and to restore the preserved of Israel.
I will also give you as a light to the nations,
that you may be my salvation to the
end of the earth.”
7 Yahweh, the Redeemer of Israel, and his
Holy One,
says to him whom man despises, to
him whom the nation abhors, to a
servant of rulers:
“Kings shall see and rise up,
princes, and they shall worship,
because of Yahweh who is faithful,
even the Holy One of Israel, who
has chosen you.”

8 Yahweh says, “I have answered you in an
acceptable time.
I have helped you in a day of
salvation.
I will preserve you and give you for a
covenant of the people,
to raise up the land, to make them
inherit the desolate heritage,
9 saying to those who are bound, ‘Come
out!’;
to those who are in darkness, ‘Show
yourselves!’
“They shall feed along the paths,
and their pasture shall be on all
treeless heights.
10 They shall not hunger nor thirst;
neither shall the heat nor sun strike
them,
for he who has mercy on them will
lead them.
He will guide them by springs of
water.
11 I will make all my mountains a road,
and my highways shall be exalted.
12 Behold, these shall come from afar,
and behold, these from the north and
from the west,
and these from the land of Sinim.”
13 Sing, heavens, and be joyful, earth!
Break out into singing, mountains!
For Yahweh has comforted his people,
and will have compassion on his
afflicted.

14 But Zion said, “Yahweh has forsaken
me,
and the Lord has forgotten me.”
15 “Can a woman forget her nursing child,
that she should not have compassion
on the son of her womb?
Yes, these may forget,
yet I will not forget you!
16 Behold, I have engraved you on the
palms of my hands.
Your walls are continually before me.
17 Your children hurry.
Your destroyers and those who
devastated you will leave you.
18 Lift up your eyes all around, and see:
all these gather themselves together,
and come to you.
As I live,” says Yahweh, “you shall surely
clothe yourself with them all as
with an ornament,
and dress yourself with them, like a
bride.

19 “For, as for your waste and your
desolate places,
and your land that has been
destroyed,
surely now that land will be too small for
the inhabitants,
and those who swallowed you up will
be far away.
20 The children of your bereavement will
say in your ears,
‘This place is too small for me.
Give me a place to live in.’
21 Then you will say in your heart, ‘Who
has conceived these for me, since I
have been bereaved of my children
and am alone, an exile, and
wandering back and forth?
Who has brought these up?
Behold, I was left alone. Where were
these?’ ”

22 The Lord Yahweh says, “Behold, I will
lift up my hand to the nations,
and lift up my banner to the peoples.
They shall bring your sons in their bosom,
and your daughters shall be carried
on their shoulders.
23 Kings shall be your foster fathers,
and their queens your nursing
mothers.
They will bow down to you with their
faces to the earth,
and lick the dust of your feet.
Then you will know that I am Yahweh;
and those who wait for me won’t be
disappointed.”

24 Shall the plunder be taken from the
mighty,
or the lawful captives be delivered?
25 But Yahweh says, “Even the captives of
the mighty shall be taken away,
and the plunder retrieved from the
fierce,
for I will contend with him who contends
with you
and I will save your children.
26 I will feed those who oppress you with
their own flesh;
and they will be drunk on their own
blood, as with sweet wine.
Then all flesh shall know that I, Yahweh,
am your Savior
and your Redeemer, the Mighty One
of Jacob.”

50

1 Yahweh says, “Where is the bill of your
mother’s divorce, with which I have
put her away?
Or to which of my creditors have I
sold you?
Behold, you were sold for your iniquities,
and your mother was put away for
your transgressions.
2 Why, when I came, was there no one?
When I called, why was there no one
to answer?
Is my hand shortened at all, that it can’t
redeem?
Or have I no power to deliver?
Behold, at my rebuke I dry up the sea.
I make the rivers a wilderness.
Their fish stink because there is no
water, and die of thirst.
3 I clothe the heavens with blackness.
I make sackcloth their covering.”

4 The Lord Yahweh has given me the
tongue of those who are taught,
that I may know how to sustain with
words him who is weary.
He awakens morning by morning,
he awakens my ear to hear as those
who are taught.
5 The Lord Yahweh has opened my ear.
I was not rebellious.
I have not turned back.
6 I gave my back to those who beat me,
and my cheeks to those who plucked
off the hair.
I didn’t hide my face from shame and
spitting.
7 For the Lord Yahweh will help me.
Therefore I have not been
confounded.
Therefore I have set my face like a flint,
and I know that I won’t be
disappointed.
8 He who justifies me is near.
Who will bring charges against me?
Let us stand up together.
Who is my adversary?
Let him come near to me.

9 Behold, the Lord Yahweh will help me!
Who is he who will condemn me?
Behold, they will all grow old like a garment.
The moths will eat them up.

10 Who among you fears Yahweh
and obeys the voice of his servant?
He who walks in darkness
and has no light,
let him trust in Yahweh's name,
and rely on his God.
11 Behold, all you who kindle a fire,
who adorn yourselves with torches around yourselves,
walk in the flame of your fire,
and among the torches that you have kindled.
You will have this from my hand:
you will lie down in sorrow.

51

1 "Listen to me, you who follow after righteousness,
you who seek Yahweh.
Look to the rock you were cut from,
and to the quarry you were dug from.
2 Look to Abraham your father,
and to Sarah who bore you;
for when he was but one I called him,
I blessed him,
and made him many.
3 For Yahweh has comforted Zion.
He has comforted all her waste places,
and has made her wilderness like Eden,
and her desert like the garden of Yahweh.
Joy and gladness will be found in them,
thanksgiving, and the voice of melody.

4 "Listen to me, my people;
and hear me, my nation,
for a law will go out from me,
and I will establish my justice for a light to the peoples.
5 My righteousness is near.
My salvation has gone out,
and my arms will judge the peoples.
The islands will wait for me,
and they will trust my arm.
6 Lift up your eyes to the heavens,
and look at the earth beneath;
for the heavens will vanish away like smoke,
and the earth will wear out like a garment.
Its inhabitants will die in the same way,
but my salvation will be forever,
and my righteousness will not be abolished.

7 "Listen to me, you who know righteousness,
the people in whose heart is my law.
Don't fear the reproach of men,
and don't be dismayed at their insults.
8 For the moth will eat them up like a garment,
and the worm will eat them like wool;
but my righteousness will be forever,
and my salvation to all generations."

9 Awake, awake, put on strength, arm of Yahweh!
Awake, as in the days of old,
the generations of ancient times.
Isn't it you who cut Rahab in pieces,
who pierced the monster?
10 Isn't it you who dried up the sea,
the waters of the great deep;
who made the depths of the sea a way for the redeemed to pass over?
11 Those ransomed by Yahweh will return,
and come with singing to Zion.
Everlasting joy shall be on their heads.
They will obtain gladness and joy.
Sorrow and sighing shall flee away.

12 "I, even I, am he who comforts you.
Who are you, that you are afraid of man who shall die,
and of the son of man who will be made as grass?
13 Have you forgotten Yahweh your Maker,
who stretched out the heavens,
and laid the foundations of the earth?
Do you live in fear continually all day because of the fury of the oppressor,
when he prepares to destroy?
Where is the fury of the oppressor?

14 The captive exile will speedily be freed.
He will not die and go down into the pit.
His bread won't fail.
15 For I am Yahweh your God, who stirs up the sea
so that its waves roar.
Yahweh of Armies is his name.
16 I have put my words in your mouth
and have covered you in the shadow of my hand,
that I may plant the heavens,
and lay the foundations of the earth,
and tell Zion, 'You are my people.' "

17 Awake, awake!
Stand up, Jerusalem,
you who have drunk from Yahweh's hand the cup of his wrath.
You have drunken the bowl of the cup of staggering,
and drained it.
18 There is no one to guide her among all the sons to whom she has given birth;
and there is no one who takes her by the hand among all the sons whom she has brought up.
19 These two things have happened to you—
who will grieve with you?—
desolation and destruction,
and famine and the sword.
How can I comfort you?
20 Your sons have fainted.
They lie at the head of all the streets,
like an antelope in a net.
They are full of Yahweh's wrath,
the rebuke of your God.

21 Therefore now hear this, you afflicted,
and drunken, but not with wine:
22 Your Lord Yahweh,
your God who pleads the cause of his people, says,
"Behold, I have taken out of your hand the cup of staggering,
even the bowl of the cup of my wrath.
You will not drink it any more.
23 I will put it into the hand of those who afflict you,
who have said to your soul, 'Bow down, that we may walk over you;'
and you have laid your back as the ground,
like a street to those who walk over."

52

1 Awake, awake! Put on your strength, Zion.
Put on your beautiful garments, Jerusalem, the holy city,
for from now on the uncircumcised and the unclean will no more come into you.
2 Shake yourself from the dust!
Arise, sit up, Jerusalem!
Release yourself from the bonds of your neck, captive daughter of Zion!

3 For Yahweh says, "You were sold for nothing;
and you will be redeemed without money."

4 For the Lord Yahweh says:
"My people went down at the first into Egypt to live there;
and the Assyrian has oppressed them without cause.

5 "Now therefore, what do I do here," says Yahweh,
"seeing that my people are taken away for nothing?
Those who rule over them mock," says Yahweh,
"and my name is blasphemed continually all day long.
6 Therefore my people shall know my name.
Therefore they shall know in that day that I am he who speaks.
Behold, it is I."

7 How beautiful on the mountains are the feet of him who brings good news,
who publishes peace,
who brings good news,
who proclaims salvation,
who says to Zion, "Your God reigns!"
8 Your watchmen lift up their voice.
Together they sing;

for they shall see eye to eye when
Yahweh returns to Zion.
9 Break out into joy!
Sing together, you waste places of
Jerusalem;
for Yahweh has comforted his people.
He has redeemed Jerusalem.
10 Yahweh has made his holy arm bare in
the eyes of all the nations.
All the ends of the earth have seen the
salvation of our God.

11 Depart! Depart! Go out from there!
Touch no unclean thing!
Go out from among her!
Cleanse yourselves, you who carry
Yahweh's vessels.
12 For you shall not go out in haste,
neither shall you go by flight;
for Yahweh will go before you,
and the God of Israel will be your rear
guard.

13 Behold, my servant will deal wisely.
He will be exalted and lifted up,
and will be very high.
14 Just as many were astonished at you—
his appearance was marred more
than any man, and his form more
than the sons of men—
15 so he will cleanse† many nations.
Kings will shut their mouths at him;
for they will see that which had not
been told them,
and they will understand that which
they had not heard.

53

1 Who has believed our message?
To whom has Yahweh's arm been
revealed?
2 For he grew up before him as a tender
plant,
and as a root out of dry ground.
He has no good looks or majesty.
When we see him, there is no beauty
that we should desire him.
3 He was despised
and rejected by men,
a man of suffering
and acquainted with disease.
He was despised as one from whom men
hide their face;
and we didn't respect him.

4 Surely he has borne our sickness
and carried our suffering;
yet we considered him plagued,
struck by God, and afflicted.
5 But he was pierced for our
transgressions.
He was crushed for our iniquities.
The punishment that brought our peace
was on him;
and by his wounds we are healed.
6 All we like sheep have gone astray.
Everyone has turned to his own way;
and Yahweh has laid on him the
iniquity of us all.

7 He was oppressed,
yet when he was afflicted he didn't
open his mouth.
As a lamb that is led to the slaughter,
and as a sheep that before its shearers
is silent,
so he didn't open his mouth.
8 He was taken away by oppression and
judgment.
As for his generation,
who considered that he was cut off
out of the land of the living
and stricken for the disobedience of
my people?
9 They made his grave with the wicked,
and with a rich man in his death,
although he had done no violence,
nor was any deceit in his mouth.

10 Yet it pleased Yahweh to bruise him.
He has caused him to suffer.
When you make his soul an offering for
sin,
he will see his offspring.
He will prolong his days
and Yahweh's pleasure will prosper
in his hand.
11 After the suffering of his soul,
he will see the light† and be satisfied.
My righteous servant will justify many by
the knowledge of himself;

† **52:15** or, sprinkle † **53:11** So read the Dead Sea Scrolls and Septuagint. Masoretic Text omits "the light".

and he will bear their iniquities.
12 Therefore I will give him a portion with the great.
He will divide the plunder with the strong,
because he poured out his soul to death
and was counted with the transgressors;
yet he bore the sins of many
and made intercession for the transgressors.

54

1 "Sing, barren, you who didn't give birth!
Break out into singing, and cry aloud, you who didn't travail with child!
For more are the children of the desolate than the children of the married wife," says Yahweh.
2 "Enlarge the place of your tent,
and let them stretch out the curtains of your habitations;
don't spare; lengthen your cords, and strengthen your stakes.
3 For you will spread out on the right hand and on the left;
and your offspring will possess the nations
and settle in desolate cities.

4 "Don't be afraid, for you will not be ashamed.
Don't be confounded, for you will not be disappointed.
For you will forget the shame of your youth.
You will remember the reproach of your widowhood no more.
5 For your Maker is your husband;
Yahweh of Armies is his name.
The Holy One of Israel is your Redeemer.
He will be called the God of the whole earth.
6 For Yahweh has called you as a wife forsaken and grieved in spirit,
even a wife of youth, when she is cast off," says your God.

7 "For a small moment I have forsaken you,
but I will gather you with great mercies.
8 In overflowing wrath I hid my face from you for a moment,
but with everlasting loving kindness I will have mercy on you," says Yahweh your Redeemer.

9 "For this is like the waters of Noah to me;
for as I have sworn that the waters of Noah will no more go over the earth,
so I have sworn that I will not be angry with you, nor rebuke you.
10 For the mountains may depart,
and the hills be removed,
but my loving kindness will not depart from you,
and my covenant of peace will not be removed,"
says Yahweh who has mercy on you.

11 "You afflicted, tossed with storms, and not comforted,
behold, I will set your stones in beautiful colors,
and lay your foundations with sapphires.
12 I will make your pinnacles of rubies,
your gates of sparkling jewels,
and all your walls of precious stones.
13 All your children will be taught by Yahweh,
and your children's peace will be great.
14 You will be established in righteousness.
You will be far from oppression,
for you will not be afraid,
and far from terror,
for it shall not come near you.
15 Behold, they may gather together, but not by me.
Whoever gathers together against you will fall because of you.

16 "Behold, I have created the blacksmith who fans the coals into flame,
and forges a weapon for his work;
and I have created the destroyer to destroy.
17 No weapon that is formed against you will prevail;
and you will condemn every tongue that rises against you in judgment.

This is the heritage of Yahweh's servants,
and their righteousness is of me,"
says Yahweh.

55

1 "Hey! Come, everyone who thirsts, to the waters!
Come, he who has no money, buy, and eat!
Yes, come, buy wine and milk without money and without price.
2 Why do you spend money for that which is not bread,
and your labor for that which doesn't satisfy?
Listen diligently to me, and eat that which is good,
and let your soul delight itself in richness.
3 Turn your ear, and come to me.
Hear, and your soul will live.
I will make an everlasting covenant with you, even the sure mercies of David.
4 Behold, I have given him for a witness to the peoples,
a leader and commander to the peoples.
5 Behold, you shall call a nation that you don't know;
and a nation that didn't know you shall run to you,
because of Yahweh your God,
and for the Holy One of Israel;
for he has glorified you."

6 Seek Yahweh while he may be found.
Call on him while he is near.
7 Let the wicked forsake his way,
and the unrighteous man his thoughts.
Let him return to Yahweh, and he will have mercy on him,
to our God, for he will freely pardon.

8 "For my thoughts are not your thoughts,
and your ways are not my ways," says Yahweh.
9 "For as the heavens are higher than the earth,
so are my ways higher than your ways,
and my thoughts than your thoughts.
10 For as the rain comes down and the snow from the sky,
and doesn't return there, but waters the earth,
and makes it grow and bud,
and gives seed to the sower and bread to the eater;
11 so is my word that goes out of my mouth:
it will not return to me void,
but it will accomplish that which I please,
and it will prosper in the thing I sent it to do.
12 For you shall go out with joy,
and be led out with peace.
The mountains and the hills will break out before you into singing;
and all the trees of the fields will clap their hands.
13 Instead of the thorn the cypress tree will come up;
and instead of the brier the myrtle tree will come up.
It will make a name for Yahweh,
for an everlasting sign that will not be cut off."

56

1 Yahweh says:
"Maintain justice
and do what is right,
for my salvation is near
and my righteousness will soon be revealed.
2 Blessed is the man who does this,
and the son of man who holds it fast;
who keeps the Sabbath without profaning it
and keeps his hand from doing any evil."

3 Let no foreigner who has joined himself to Yahweh speak, saying,
"Yahweh will surely separate me from his people."
Do not let the eunuch say, "Behold, I am a dry tree."

4 For Yahweh says, "To the eunuchs who keep my Sabbaths,
choose the things that please me,
and hold fast to my covenant,

5 I will give them in my house and within
my walls a memorial and a name
better than of sons and of
daughters.
I will give them an everlasting name
that will not be cut off.

6 Also the foreigners who join themselves
to Yahweh
to serve him,
and to love Yahweh's name,
to be his servants,
everyone who keeps the Sabbath from
profaning it,
and holds fast my covenant,
7 I will bring these to my holy mountain,
and make them joyful in my house of
prayer.
Their burnt offerings and their sacrifices
will be accepted on my altar;
for my house will be called a house of
prayer for all peoples."
8 The Lord Yahweh, who gathers the
outcasts of Israel, says,
"I will yet gather others to him,
in addition to his own who are
gathered."

9 All you animals of the field,
come to devour,
all you animals in the forest.
10 His watchmen are blind.
They are all without knowledge.
They are all mute dogs.
They can't bark—
dreaming, lying down, loving to
slumber.
11 Yes, the dogs are greedy.
They can never have enough.
They are shepherds who can't
understand.
They have all turned to their own
way,
each one to his gain, from every
quarter.
12 "Come," they say, "I will get wine,
and we will fill ourselves with strong
drink;
and tomorrow will be as today,
great beyond measure."

57

1 The righteous perish,
and no one lays it to heart.
Merciful men are taken away,
and no one considers that the
righteous is taken away from the
evil.
2 He enters into peace.
They rest in their beds,
each one who walks in his
uprightness.

3 "But draw near here, you sons of a
sorceress,
you offspring of adulterers and
prostitutes.
4 Whom do you mock?
Against whom do you make a wide
mouth
and stick out your tongue?
Aren't you children of disobedience
and offspring of falsehood,
5 you who inflame yourselves among the
oaks,
under every green tree;
who kill the children in the valleys,
under the clefts of the rocks?
6 Among the smooth stones of the valley is
your portion.
They, they are your lot.
You have even poured a drink offering to
them.
You have offered an offering.
Shall I be appeased for these things?
7 On a high and lofty mountain you have
set your bed.
You also went up there to offer
sacrifice.
8 You have set up your memorial behind
the doors and the posts,
for you have exposed yourself to
someone besides me,
and have gone up.
You have enlarged your bed
and made a covenant for yourself
with them.
You loved what you saw on their bed.
9 You went to the king with oil,
increased your perfumes,
sent your ambassadors far off,
and degraded yourself even to Sheol.†

† **57:9** Sheol is the place of the dead.

10 You were wearied with the length of your ways;
yet you didn't say, 'It is in vain.'
You found a reviving of your strength;
therefore you weren't faint.

11 "Whom have you dreaded and feared,
so that you lie,
and have not remembered me, nor laid it to your heart?
Haven't I held my peace for a long time,
and you don't fear me?
12 I will declare your righteousness;
and as for your works, they will not benefit you.
13 When you cry,
let those whom you have gathered deliver you,
but the wind will take them.
A breath will carry them all away,
but he who takes refuge in me will possess the land,
and will inherit my holy mountain."

14 He will say, "Build up, build up, prepare the way!
Remove the stumbling-block out of the way of my people."
15 For the high and lofty One who inhabits eternity,
whose name is Holy, says:
"I dwell in the high and holy place, with him also who is of a contrite and humble spirit,
to revive the spirit of the humble,
and to revive the heart of the contrite.
16 For I will not contend forever, neither will I always be angry;
for the spirit would faint before me,
and the souls whom I have made.
17 I was angry because of the iniquity of his covetousness and struck him.
I hid myself and was angry;
and he went on backsliding in the way of his heart.
18 I have seen his ways, and will heal him.
I will lead him also,
and restore comforts to him and to his mourners.
19 I create the fruit of the lips:
Peace, peace, to him who is far off and to him who is near,"
says Yahweh; "and I will heal them."
20 But the wicked are like the troubled sea;
for it can't rest and its waters cast up mire and mud.
21 "There is no peace", says my God,
"for the wicked."

58

1 "Cry aloud! Don't spare!
Lift up your voice like a trumpet!
Declare to my people their disobedience,
and to the house of Jacob their sins.
2 Yet they seek me daily,
and delight to know my ways.
As a nation that did righteousness,
and didn't forsake the ordinance of their God,
they ask of me righteous judgments.
They delight to draw near to God.
3 'Why have we fasted,' they say, 'and you don't see?
Why have we afflicted our soul, and you don't notice?'

"Behold, in the day of your fast you find pleasure,
and oppress all your laborers.
4 Behold, you fast for strife and contention,
and to strike with the fist of wickedness.
You don't fast today so as to make your voice to be heard on high.
5 Is this the fast that I have chosen?
A day for a man to humble his soul?
Is it to bow down his head like a reed,
and to spread sackcloth and ashes under himself?
Will you call this a fast,
and an acceptable day to Yahweh?

6 "Isn't this the fast that I have chosen:
to release the bonds of wickedness,
to undo the straps of the yoke,
to let the oppressed go free,
and that you break every yoke?
7 Isn't it to distribute your bread to the hungry,
and that you bring the poor who are cast out to your house?
When you see the naked,
that you cover him;

and that you not hide yourself from
your own flesh?
8 Then your light will break out as the
morning,
and your healing will appear quickly;
then your righteousness shall go before
you,
and Yahweh's glory will be your rear
guard.
9 Then you will call, and Yahweh will
answer.
You will cry for help, and he will say,
'Here I am.'

"If you take away from among you the
yoke,
finger pointing,
and speaking wickedly;
10 and if you pour out your soul to the
hungry,
and satisfy the afflicted soul,
then your light will rise in darkness,
and your obscurity will be as the
noonday;
11 and Yahweh will guide you continually,
satisfy your soul in dry places,
and make your bones strong.
You will be like a watered garden,
and like a spring of water
whose waters don't fail.
12 Those who will be of you will build the
old waste places.
You will raise up the foundations of
many generations.
You will be called Repairer of the Breach,
Restorer of Paths with Dwellings.

13 "If you turn away your foot from the
Sabbath,
from doing your pleasure on my holy
day,
and call the Sabbath a delight,
and the holy of Yahweh honorable,
and honor it,
not doing your own ways,
nor finding your own pleasure,
nor speaking your own words,
14 then you will delight yourself in
Yahweh,
and I will make you to ride on the
high places of the earth,
and I will feed you with the heritage
of Jacob your father;"
for Yahweh's mouth has spoken it.

59

1 Behold, Yahweh's hand is not shortened,
that it can't save;
nor his ear dull, that it can't hear.
2 But your iniquities have separated you
and your God,
and your sins have hidden his face
from you,
so that he will not hear.
3 For your hands are defiled with blood,
and your fingers with iniquity.
Your lips have spoken lies.
Your tongue mutters wickedness.
4 No one sues in righteousness,
and no one pleads in truth.
They trust in vanity
and speak lies.
They conceive mischief
and give birth to iniquity.
5 They hatch adders' eggs
and weave the spider's web.
He who eats of their eggs dies;
and that which is crushed breaks out
into a viper.
6 Their webs won't become garments.
They won't cover themselves with
their works.
Their works are works of iniquity,
and acts of violence are in their
hands.
7 Their feet run to evil,
and they hurry to shed innocent
blood.
Their thoughts are thoughts of iniquity.
Desolation and destruction are in
their paths.
8 They don't know the way of peace;
and there is no justice in their ways.
They have made crooked paths for
themselves;
whoever goes in them doesn't know
peace.

9 Therefore justice is far from us,
and righteousness doesn't overtake
us.
We look for light, but see darkness;
for brightness, but we walk in
obscurity.

10 We grope for the wall like the blind.
Yes, we grope as those who have no eyes.
We stumble at noon as if it were twilight.
Among those who are strong, we are like dead men.
11 We all roar like bears
and moan sadly like doves.
We look for justice, but there is none,
for salvation, but it is far off from us.

12 For our transgressions are multiplied before you,
and our sins testify against us;
for our transgressions are with us,
and as for our iniquities, we know them:
13 transgressing and denying Yahweh,
and turning away from following our God,
speaking oppression and revolt,
conceiving and uttering from the heart words of falsehood.
14 Justice is turned away backward,
and righteousness stands far away;
for truth has fallen in the street,
and uprightness can't enter.
15 Yes, truth is lacking;
and he who departs from evil makes himself a prey.

Yahweh saw it,
and it displeased him that there was no justice.
16 He saw that there was no man,
and wondered that there was no intercessor.
Therefore his own arm brought salvation to him;
and his righteousness sustained him.
17 He put on righteousness as a breastplate,
and a helmet of salvation on his head.
He put on garments of vengeance for clothing,
and was clad with zeal as a mantle.
18 According to their deeds,
he will repay as appropriate:
wrath to his adversaries,
recompense to his enemies.
He will repay the islands their due.
19 So they will fear Yahweh's name from the west,
and his glory from the rising of the sun;
for he will come as a rushing stream,
which Yahweh's breath drives.

20 "A Redeemer will come to Zion,
and to those who turn from disobedience in Jacob," says Yahweh.
21 "As for me, this is my covenant with them," says Yahweh. "My Spirit who is on you, and my words which I have put in your mouth shall not depart out of your mouth, nor out of the mouth of your offspring, nor out of the mouth of your offspring's offspring," says Yahweh, "from now on and forever."

60

1 "Arise, shine; for your light has come,
and Yahweh's glory has risen on you!
2 For behold, darkness will cover the earth,
and thick darkness the peoples;
but Yahweh will arise on you,
and his glory shall be seen on you.
3 Nations will come to your light,
and kings to the brightness of your rising.

4 "Lift up your eyes all around, and see:
they all gather themselves together.
They come to you.
Your sons will come from far away,
and your daughters will be carried in arms.
5 Then you shall see and be radiant,
and your heart will thrill and be enlarged;
because the abundance of the sea will be turned to you.
The wealth of the nations will come to you.
6 A multitude of camels will cover you,
the dromedaries of Midian and Ephah.
All from Sheba will come.
They will bring gold and frankincense,
and will proclaim the praises of Yahweh.
7 All the flocks of Kedar will be gathered together to you.

The rams of Nebaioth will serve you.
They will be accepted as offerings on my altar;
and I will beautify my glorious house.

8 "Who are these who fly as a cloud,
and as the doves to their windows?
9 Surely the islands will wait for me,
and the ships of Tarshish first,
to bring your sons from far away,
their silver and their gold with them,
for the name of Yahweh your God,
and for the Holy One of Israel,
because he has glorified you.

10 "Foreigners will build up your walls,
and their kings will serve you;
for in my wrath I struck you,
but in my favor I have had mercy on you.
11 Your gates also shall be open
continually; they shall not be shut
day nor night, that men may bring
to you the wealth of the nations,
and their kings led captive.
12 For that nation and kingdom that will
not serve you shall perish; yes,
those nations shall be utterly
wasted.

13 "The glory of Lebanon shall come to
you, the cypress tree, the pine, and
the box tree together, to beautify
the place of my sanctuary; and I will
make the place of my feet glorious.
14 The sons of those who afflicted you will
come bowing to you;
and all those who despised you will
bow themselves down at the soles
of your feet.
They will call you Yahweh's City,
the Zion of the Holy One of Israel.

15 "Whereas you have been forsaken and
hated,
so that no one passed through you,
I will make you an eternal excellency,
a joy of many generations.
16 You will also drink the milk of the
nations,
and will nurse from royal breasts.
Then you will know that I, Yahweh, am
your Savior,
your Redeemer,
the Mighty One of Jacob.
17 For bronze I will bring gold;
for iron I will bring silver;
for wood, bronze,
and for stones, iron.
I will also make peace your governor,
and righteousness your ruler.
18 Violence shall no more be heard in your
land,
nor desolation or destruction within
your borders;
but you will call your walls Salvation,
and your gates Praise.
19 The sun will be no more your light by
day,
nor will the brightness of the moon
give light to you,
but Yahweh will be your everlasting light,
and your God will be your glory.
20 Your sun will not go down any more,
nor will your moon withdraw itself;
for Yahweh will be your everlasting light,
and the days of your mourning will
end.
21 Then your people will all be righteous.
They will inherit the land forever,
the branch of my planting,
the work of my hands,
that I may be glorified.
22 The little one will become a thousand,
and the small one a strong nation.
I, Yahweh, will do this quickly in its
time."

61

1 The Lord Yahweh's Spirit is on me,
because Yahweh has anointed me to
preach good news to the humble.
He has sent me to bind up the broken
hearted,
to proclaim liberty to the captives
and release to those who are bound,†
2 to proclaim the year of Yahweh's favor
and the day of vengeance of our God,
to comfort all who mourn,
3 to provide for those who mourn in Zion,
to give to them a garland for ashes,

† **61:1** LXX and DSS add: recovery of sight to the blind

the oil of joy for mourning,
the garment of praise for the spirit of heaviness,
that they may be called trees of righteousness,
the planting of Yahweh,
that he may be glorified.

4 They will rebuild the old ruins.
They will raise up the former devastated places.
They will repair the ruined cities
that have been devastated for many generations.
5 Strangers will stand and feed your flocks.
Foreigners will work your fields and your vineyards.
6 But you will be called Yahweh's priests.
Men will call you the servants of our God.
You will eat the wealth of the nations.
You will boast in their glory.
7 Instead of your shame you will have double.
Instead of dishonor, they will rejoice in their portion.
Therefore in their land they will possess double.
Everlasting joy will be to them.
8 "For I, Yahweh, love justice.
I hate robbery and iniquity.
I will give them their reward in truth
and I will make an everlasting covenant with them.
9 Their offspring will be known among the nations,
and their offspring among the peoples.
All who see them will acknowledge them,
that they are the offspring which Yahweh has blessed."

10 I will greatly rejoice in Yahweh!
My soul will be joyful in my God,
for he has clothed me with the garments of salvation.
He has covered me with the robe of righteousness,
as a bridegroom decks himself with a garland
and as a bride adorns herself with her jewels.
11 For as the earth produces its bud,
and as the garden causes the things that are sown in it to spring up,
so the Lord Yahweh will cause righteousness and praise to spring up before all the nations.

62

1 For Zion's sake I will not hold my peace,
and for Jerusalem's sake I will not rest,
until her righteousness shines out like the dawn,
and her salvation like a burning lamp.
2 The nations will see your righteousness,
and all kings your glory.
You will be called by a new name,
which Yahweh's mouth will name.
3 You will also be a crown of beauty in Yahweh's hand,
and a royal diadem in your God's hand.
4 You will not be called Forsaken any more,
nor will your land be called Desolate any more;
but you will be called Hephzibah,†
and your land Beulah;‡
for Yahweh delights in you,
and your land will be married.
5 For as a young man marries a virgin,
so your sons will marry you.
As a bridegroom rejoices over his bride,
so your God will rejoice over you.

6 I have set watchmen on your walls, Jerusalem.
They will never be silent day nor night.
You who call on Yahweh, take no rest,
7 and give him no rest until he establishes,
and until he makes Jerusalem a praise in the earth.

8 Yahweh has sworn by his right hand,
and by the arm of his strength,
"Surely I will no more give your grain to be food for your enemies,

† **62:4** Hephzibah means "I delight in her". ‡ **62:4** Beulah means "married"

and foreigners will not drink your
new wine, for which you have
labored,
9 but those who have harvested it will eat
it, and praise Yahweh.
Those who have gathered it will drink
it in the courts of my sanctuary."

10 Go through, go through the gates!
Prepare the way of the people!
Build up, build up the highway!
Gather out the stones!
Lift up a banner for the peoples.
11 Behold, Yahweh has proclaimed to the
end of the earth:
"Say to the daughter of Zion,
'Behold, your salvation comes!
Behold, his reward is with him,
and his recompense before him!' "
12 They will call them "The Holy People,
Yahweh's Redeemed".
You will be called "Sought Out,
A City Not Forsaken".

63

1 Who is this who comes from Edom,
with dyed garments from Bozrah?
Who is this who is glorious in his clothing,
marching in the greatness of his
strength?
"It is I who speak in righteousness,
mighty to save."
2 Why is your clothing red,
and your garments like him who
treads in the wine vat?

3 "I have trodden the wine press alone.
Of the peoples, no one was with me.
Yes, I trod them in my anger
and trampled them in my wrath.
Their lifeblood is sprinkled on my
garments,
and I have stained all my clothing.
4 For the day of vengeance was in my
heart,
and the year of my redeemed has
come.
5 I looked, and there was no one to help;
and I wondered that there was no one
to uphold.
Therefore my own arm brought salvation
to me.
My own wrath upheld me.
6 I trod down the peoples in my anger
and made them drunk in my wrath.
I poured their lifeblood out on the
earth."

7 I will tell of the loving kindnesses of
Yahweh
and the praises of Yahweh,
according to all that Yahweh has
given to us,
and the great goodness toward the house
of Israel,
which he has given to them according
to his mercies,
and according to the multitude of his
loving kindnesses.
8 For he said, "Surely, they are my people,
children who will not deal falsely;"
so he became their Savior.
9 In all their affliction he was afflicted,
and the angel of his presence saved
them.
In his love and in his pity he redeemed
them.
He bore them,
and carried them all the days of old.

10 But they rebelled
and grieved his Holy Spirit.
Therefore he turned and became their
enemy,
and he himself fought against them.

11 Then he remembered the days of old,
Moses and his people, saying,
"Where is he who brought them up out of
the sea with the shepherds of his
flock?
Where is he who put his Holy Spirit
among them?"
12 Who caused his glorious arm to be at
Moses' right hand?
Who divided the waters before them,
to make himself an everlasting
name?
13 Who led them through the depths,
like a horse in the wilderness,
so that they didn't stumble?
14 As the livestock that go down into the
valley,
Yahweh's Spirit caused them to rest.
So you led your people to make
yourself a glorious name.

15 Look down from heaven,
and see from the habitation of your holiness and of your glory.
Where are your zeal and your mighty acts?
The yearning of your heart and your compassion is restrained toward me.
16 For you are our Father,
though Abraham doesn't know us,
and Israel does not acknowledge us.
You, Yahweh, are our Father.
Our Redeemer from everlasting is your name.
17 O Yahweh, why do you make us wander from your ways,
and harden our heart from your fear?
Return for your servants' sake,
the tribes of your inheritance.
18 Your holy people possessed it but a little while.
Our adversaries have trodden down your sanctuary.
19 We have become like those over whom you never ruled,
like those who were not called by your name.

64

1 Oh that you would tear the heavens,
that you would come down,
that the mountains might quake at your presence—
2 as when fire kindles the brushwood,
and the fire causes the water to boil.
Make your name known to your adversaries,
that the nations may tremble at your presence!
3 When you did awesome things which we didn't look for,
you came down, and the mountains quaked at your presence.
4 For from of old men have not heard,
nor perceived by the ear,
nor has the eye seen a God besides you,
who works for him who waits for him.
5 You meet him who rejoices and does righteousness,
those who remember you in your ways.
Behold, you were angry, and we sinned.
We have been in sin for a long time.
Shall we be saved?
6 For we have all become like one who is unclean,
and all our righteousness is like a polluted garment.
We all fade like a leaf;
and our iniquities, like the wind, take us away.
7 There is no one who calls on your name,
who stirs himself up to take hold of you;
for you have hidden your face from us,
and have consumed us by means of our iniquities.

8 But now, Yahweh, you are our Father.
We are the clay and you our potter.
We all are the work of your hand.
9 Don't be furious, Yahweh.
Don't remember iniquity forever.
Look and see, we beg you,
we are all your people.
10 Your holy cities have become a wilderness.
Zion has become a wilderness,
Jerusalem a desolation.
11 Our holy and our beautiful house where our fathers praised you
is burned with fire.
All our pleasant places are laid waste.
12 Will you hold yourself back for these things, Yahweh?
Will you keep silent and punish us very severely?

65

1 "I am inquired of by those who didn't ask.
I am found by those who didn't seek me.
I said, 'See me, see me,' to a nation that was not called by my name.
2 I have spread out my hands all day to a rebellious people,
who walk in a way that is not good,
after their own thoughts;
3 a people who provoke me to my face continually,
sacrificing in gardens,
and burning incense on bricks;

4 who sit among the graves,
and spend nights in secret places;
who eat pig's meat,
and broth of abominable things is in their vessels;
5 who say, 'Stay by yourself,
don't come near to me,
for I am holier than you.'
These are smoke in my nose,
a fire that burns all day.

6 "Behold, it is written before me:
I will not keep silence,
but will repay,
yes, I will repay into their bosom
7 your own iniquities and the iniquities of your fathers together", says Yahweh,
"who have burned incense on the mountains,
and blasphemed me on the hills.
Therefore I will first measure their work into their bosom."

8 Yahweh says,
"As the new wine is found in the cluster,
and one says, 'Don't destroy it, for a blessing is in it:'
so I will do for my servants' sake,
that I may not destroy them all.
9 I will bring offspring out of Jacob,
and out of Judah an inheritor of my mountains.
My chosen will inherit it,
and my servants will dwell there.
10 Sharon will be a fold of flocks,
and the valley of Achor a place for herds to lie down in,
for my people who have sought me.

11 "But you who forsake Yahweh,
who forget my holy mountain,
who prepare a table for Fortune,
and who fill up mixed wine to Destiny;
12 I will destine you to the sword,
and you will all bow down to the slaughter;
because when I called, you didn't answer.
When I spoke, you didn't listen;
but you did that which was evil in my eyes,
and chose that in which I didn't delight."

13 Therefore the Lord Yahweh says,
"Behold, my servants will eat,
but you will be hungry;
behold, my servants will drink,
but you will be thirsty.
Behold, my servants will rejoice,
but you will be disappointed.
14 Behold, my servants will sing for joy of heart,
but you will cry for sorrow of heart,
and will wail for anguish of spirit.
15 You will leave your name for a curse to my chosen,
and the Lord Yahweh will kill you.
He will call his servants by another name,
16 so that he who blesses himself in the earth will bless himself in the God of truth;
and he who swears in the earth will swear by the God of truth;
because the former troubles are forgotten,
and because they are hidden from my eyes.

17 "For, behold, I create new heavens and a new earth;
and the former things will not be remembered,
nor come into mind.
18 But be glad and rejoice forever in that which I create;
for, behold, I create Jerusalem to be a delight,
and her people a joy.
19 I will rejoice in Jerusalem,
and delight in my people;
and the voice of weeping and the voice of crying
will be heard in her no more.

20 "No more will there be an infant who only lives a few days,
nor an old man who has not filled his days;
for the child will die one hundred years old,
and the sinner being one hundred years old will be accursed.
21 They will build houses and inhabit them.

They will plant vineyards and eat
their fruit.
22 They will not build and another inhabit.
They will not plant and another eat;
for the days of my people will be like the
days of a tree,
and my chosen will long enjoy the
work of their hands.
23 They will not labor in vain
nor give birth for calamity;
for they are the offspring of Yahweh's
blessed
and their descendants with them.
24 It will happen that before they call, I
will answer;
and while they are yet speaking, I will
hear.
25 The wolf and the lamb will feed
together.
The lion will eat straw like the ox.
Dust will be the serpent's food.
They will not hurt nor destroy in all my
holy mountain,"
says Yahweh.

66

1 Yahweh says:
"Heaven is my throne, and the earth is my
footstool.
What kind of house will you build to
me?
Where will I rest?
2 For my hand has made all these things,
and so all these things came to be,"
says Yahweh:
"but I will look to this man,
even to he who is poor and of a
contrite spirit,
and who trembles at my word.
3 He who kills an ox is as he who kills a
man;
he who sacrifices a lamb, as he who
breaks a dog's neck;
he who offers an offering, as he who
offers pig's blood;
he who burns frankincense, as he
who blesses an idol.
Yes, they have chosen their own ways,
and their soul delights in their
abominations.
4 I also will choose their delusions,
and will bring their fears on them,
because when I called, no one answered;
when I spoke, they didn't listen,
but they did that which was evil in my
eyes,
and chose that in which I didn't
delight."

5 Hear Yahweh's word,
you who tremble at his word:
"Your brothers who hate you,
who cast you out for my name's sake,
have said,
'Let Yahweh be glorified,
that we may see your joy;'
but it is those who shall be
disappointed.
6 A voice of tumult from the city,
a voice from the temple,
a voice of Yahweh that repays his
enemies what they deserve.

7 "Before she travailed, she gave birth.
Before her pain came, she delivered a
son.
8 Who has heard of such a thing?
Who has seen such things?
Shall a land be born in one day?
Shall a nation be born at once?
For as soon as Zion travailed,
she gave birth to her children.
9 Shall I bring to the birth, and not cause to
be delivered?" says Yahweh.
"Shall I who cause to give birth shut
the womb?" says your God.

10 "Rejoice with Jerusalem, and be glad for
her, all you who love her.
Rejoice for joy with her, all you who
mourn over her;
11 that you may nurse and be satisfied at
the comforting breasts;
that you may drink deeply,
and be delighted with the abundance
of her glory."

12 For Yahweh says, "Behold, I will extend
peace to her like a river,
and the glory of the nations like an
overflowing stream,
and you will nurse.
You will be carried on her side,
and will be dandled on her knees.
13 As one whom his mother comforts,
so I will comfort you.

You will be comforted in Jerusalem."

14 You will see it, and your heart shall
rejoice,
and your bones will flourish like the
tender grass.
Yahweh's hand will be known among his
servants;
and he will have indignation against
his enemies.

15 For, behold, Yahweh will come with fire,
and his chariots will be like the
whirlwind;
to give his anger with fierceness,
and his rebuke with flames of fire.
16 For Yahweh will execute judgment by
fire and by his sword on all flesh;
and those slain by Yahweh will be
many.
17 "Those who sanctify themselves and purify themselves to go to the gardens, following one in the middle, eating pig's meat, abominable things, and the mouse, they shall come to an end together," says Yahweh.
18 "For I know their works and their thoughts. The time comes that I will gather all nations and languages, and they will come, and will see my glory.
19 "I will set a sign among them, and I will send those who escape of them to the nations, to Tarshish, Pul, and Lud, who draw the bow, to Tubal and Javan, to far-away islands, who have not heard my fame, nor have seen my glory; and they shall declare my glory among the nations.
20 They shall bring all your brothers out of all the nations for an offering to Yahweh, on horses, in chariots, in litters, on mules, and on camels, to my holy mountain Jerusalem, says Yahweh, as the children of Israel bring their offering in a clean vessel into Yahweh's house.
21 Of them I will also select priests and Levites," says Yahweh.
22 "For as the new heavens and the new earth, which I will make, shall remain before me," says Yahweh, "so your offspring and your name shall remain.
23 It shall happen that from one new moon to another, and from one Sabbath to another, all flesh will come to worship before me," says Yahweh.
24 "They will go out, and look at the dead bodies of the men who have transgressed against me; for their worm will not die, nor will their fire be quenched, and they will be loathsome to all mankind."

The Book of Jeremiah

1 The words of Jeremiah the son of
Hilkiah, one of the priests who were in
Anathoth in the land of Benjamin.
2 Yahweh's† word came to him in the
days of Josiah the son of Amon, king of
Judah, in the thirteenth year of his reign.
3 It came also in the days of Jehoiakim
the son of Josiah, king of Judah, to the end
of the eleventh year of Zedekiah, the son
of Josiah, king of Judah, to the carrying
away of Jerusalem captive in the fifth
month.
4 Now Yahweh's word came to me,
saying,
5 "Before I formed you in the womb, I
knew you.
Before you were born, I sanctified
you.
I have appointed you a prophet to the
nations."
6 Then I said, "Ah, Lord‡ Yahweh!
Behold,§ I don't know how to speak; for I
am a child."
7 But Yahweh said to me, "Don't say, 'I
am a child;' for you must go to whomever
I send you, and you must say whatever I
command you.
8 Don't be afraid because of them, for I
am with you to rescue you," says Yahweh.
9 Then Yahweh stretched out his hand
and touched my mouth. Then Yahweh
said to me, "Behold, I have put my words
in your mouth.
10 Behold, I have today set you over the
nations and over the kingdoms, to uproot
and to tear down, to destroy and to
overthrow, to build and to plant."
11 Moreover Yahweh's word came to
me, saying, "Jeremiah, what do you see?"
I said, "I see a branch of an almond
tree."
12 Then Yahweh said to me, "You have
seen well; for I watch over my word to
perform it."
13 Yahweh's word came to me the
second time, saying, "What do you see?"
I said, "I see a boiling cauldron; and it is
tipping away from the north."
14 Then Yahweh said to me, "Out of the
north, evil will break out on all the
inhabitants of the land.
15 For behold, I will call all the families
of the kingdoms of the north," says
Yahweh.
"They will come, and they will each set his
throne at the entrance of the gates
of Jerusalem,
and against all its walls all around,
and against all the cities of Judah.
16 I will utter my judgments against them
concerning all their wickedness,
in that they have forsaken me,
and have burned incense to other
gods,
and worshiped the works of their
own hands.
17 "You therefore put your belt on your
waist, arise, and say to them all that I
command you. Don't be dismayed at
them, lest I dismay you before them.
18 For behold, I have made you today a
fortified city, an iron pillar, and bronze
walls against the whole land—against the
kings of Judah, against its princes, against
its priests, and against the people of the
land.
19 They will fight against you, but they
will not prevail against you; for I am with
you", says Yahweh, "to rescue you."

2

1 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
2 "Go and proclaim in the ears of
Jerusalem, saying, 'Yahweh says,
"I remember for you the kindness of your
youth,
your love as a bride,
how you went after me in the wilderness,
in a land that was not sown.
3 Israel was holiness to Yahweh,
the first fruits of his increase.
All who devour him will be held guilty.

† **1:2** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:6** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." § **1:6** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

Evil will come on them,” ’ says
Yahweh.”
4 Hear Yahweh’s word, O house of Jacob,
and all the families of the house of Israel!
5 Yahweh says,
“What unrighteousness have your fathers
found in me,
that they have gone far from me,
and have walked after worthless vanity,
and have become worthless?
6 They didn’t say, ‘Where is Yahweh who
brought us up out of the land of
Egypt,
who led us through the wilderness,
through a land of deserts and of pits,
through a land of drought and of the
shadow of death,
through a land that no one passed
through,
and where no man lived?’
7 I brought you into a plentiful land
to eat its fruit and its goodness;
but when you entered, you defiled my
land,
and made my heritage an
abomination.
8 The priests didn’t say, ‘Where is
Yahweh?’
and those who handle the law didn’t
know me.
The rulers also transgressed against me,
and the prophets prophesied by Baal
and followed things that do not profit.
9 “Therefore I will yet contend with you,”
says Yahweh,
“and I will contend with your
children’s children.
10 For pass over to the islands of Kittim,
and see.
Send to Kedar, and consider
diligently,
and see if there has been such a thing.
11 Has a nation changed its gods,
which really are no gods?
But my people have changed their
glory for that which doesn’t profit.
12 “Be astonished, you heavens, at this
and be horribly afraid.
Be very desolate,” says Yahweh.
13 “For my people have committed two
evils:
they have forsaken me, the spring of
living waters,
and cut out cisterns for themselves:
broken cisterns that can’t hold
water.
14 Is Israel a slave?
Is he born into slavery?
Why has he become a captive?
15 The young lions have roared at him and
raised their voices.
They have made his land waste.
His cities are burned up, without
inhabitant.
16 The children also of Memphis and
Tahpanhes have broken the crown
of your head.
17 “Haven’t you brought this on yourself,
in that you have forsaken Yahweh
your God,† when he led you by the
way?
18 Now what do you gain by going to Egypt,
to drink the waters of the Shihor?
Or why do you go on the way to
Assyria, to drink the waters of the
River?‡
19 “Your own wickedness will correct you,
and your backsliding will rebuke you.
Know therefore and see that it is an evil
and bitter thing,
that you have forsaken Yahweh your
God,
and that my fear is not in you,” says
the Lord, Yahweh of Armies.
20 “For long ago I broke off your yoke,
and burst your bonds.
You said, ‘I will not serve;’
for on every high hill and under every
green tree you bowed yourself,
playing the prostitute.
21 Yet I had planted you a noble vine,
a pure and faithful seed.
How then have you turned into the
degenerate branches of a foreign
vine to me?
22 For though you wash yourself with lye,
and use much soap,
yet your iniquity is marked before
me,” says the Lord Yahweh.
23 “How can you say, ‘I am not defiled.
I have not gone after the Baals’?
See your way in the valley.

† **2:17** The Hebrew word rendered “God” is “אֱלֹהִים” (Elohim). ‡ **2:18** i.e., the Euphrates River

Know what you have done.
You are a swift dromedary traversing her ways,
24 a wild donkey used to the wilderness,
that sniffs the wind in her craving.
When she is in heat, who can turn her away?
All those who seek her will not weary themselves. In her month, they will find her.
25 "Keep your feet from being bare,
and your throat from thirst.
But you said, 'It is in vain.
No, for I have loved strangers,
and I will go after them.'
26 As the thief is ashamed when he is found,
so the house of Israel is ashamed—
they, their kings, their princes, their priests, and their prophets,
27 who tell wood, 'You are my father,'
and a stone, 'You have given birth to me,'
for they have turned their back to me,
and not their face,
but in the time of their trouble they will say, 'Arise, and save us!'
28 "But where are your gods that you have made for yourselves?
Let them arise, if they can save you in the time of your trouble,
for you have as many gods as you have towns, O Judah.
29 "Why will you contend with me?
You all have transgressed against me," says Yahweh.
30 "I have struck your children in vain.
They received no correction.
Your own sword has devoured your prophets,
like a destroying lion.
31 Generation, consider Yahweh's word.
Have I been a wilderness to Israel?
Or a land of thick darkness?
Why do my people say, 'We have broken loose.
We will come to you no more'?
32 "Can a virgin forget her ornaments,
or a bride her attire?
Yet my people have forgotten me for days without number.
33 How well you prepare your way to seek love!
Therefore you have even taught the wicked women your ways.
34 Also the blood of the souls of the innocent poor is found in your skirts.
You didn't find them breaking in,
but it is because of all these things.
35 "Yet you said, 'I am innocent.
Surely his anger has turned away from me.'
"Behold, I will judge you,
because you say, 'I have not sinned.'
36 Why do you go about so much to change your ways?
You will be ashamed of Egypt also,
as you were ashamed of Assyria.
37 You will also leave that place with your hands on your head;
for Yahweh has rejected those in whom you trust,
and you won't prosper with them.

3

1 "They say, 'If a man puts away his wife, and she goes from him, and becomes another man's, should he return to her again?' Wouldn't that land be greatly polluted? But you have played the prostitute with many lovers; yet return again to me," says Yahweh.
2 "Lift up your eyes to the bare heights, and see! Where have you not been lain with? You have sat waiting for them by the road, as an Arabian in the wilderness. You have polluted the land with your prostitution and with your wickedness.
3 Therefore the showers have been withheld and there has been no latter rain; yet you have had a prostitute's forehead and you refused to be ashamed.
4 Will you not from this time cry to me, 'My Father, you are the guide of my youth!'?
5 " 'Will he retain his anger forever? Will he keep it to the end?' Behold, you have spoken and have done evil things, and have had your way."
6 Moreover, Yahweh said to me in the days of Josiah the king, "Have you seen that which backsliding Israel has done?

She has gone up on every high mountain
and under every green tree, and has
played the prostitute there.
7 I said after she had done all these
things, 'She will return to me;' but she
didn't return, and her treacherous sister
Judah saw it.
8 I saw when, for this very cause, that
backsliding Israel had committed
adultery, I had put her away and given
her a certificate of divorce, yet
treacherous Judah, her sister, had no fear,
but she also went and played the
prostitute.
9 Because she took her prostitution
lightly, the land was polluted, and she
committed adultery with stones and with
wood.
10 Yet for all this her treacherous sister,
Judah, has not returned to me with her
whole heart, but only in pretense," says
Yahweh.
11 Yahweh said to me, "Backsliding
Israel has shown herself more righteous
than treacherous Judah.
12 Go, and proclaim these words toward
the north, and say, 'Return, you
backsliding Israel,' says Yahweh; 'I will
not look in anger on you, for I am
merciful,' says Yahweh. 'I will not keep
anger forever.
13 Only acknowledge your iniquity, that
you have transgressed against Yahweh
your God, and have scattered your ways
to the strangers under every green tree,
and you have not obeyed my voice,' " says
Yahweh.
14 "Return, backsliding children," says
Yahweh, "for I am a husband to you. I will
take one of you from a city, and two from
a family, and I will bring you to Zion.
15 I will give you shepherds according to
my heart, who will feed you with
knowledge and understanding.
16 It will come to pass, when you are
multiplied and increased in the land in
those days," says Yahweh, "they will no
longer say, 'the ark of Yahweh's
covenant!' It will not come to mind. They
won't remember it. They won't miss it,
nor will another be made.
17 At that time they will call Jerusalem
'Yahweh's Throne;' and all the nations will
be gathered to it, to Yahweh's name, to
Jerusalem. They will no longer walk after
the stubbornness of their evil heart.
18 In those days the house of Judah will
walk with the house of Israel, and they
will come together out of the land of the
north to the land that I gave for an
inheritance to your fathers.
19 "But I said, 'How I desire to put you
among the children, and give you a
pleasant land, a goodly heritage of the
armies of the nations!' and I said, 'You
shall call me "My Father", and shall not
turn away from following me.'
20 "Surely as a wife treacherously
departs from her husband, so you have
dealt treacherously with me, house of
Israel," says Yahweh.
21 A voice is heard on the bare heights,
the weeping and the petitions of the
children of Israel; because they have
perverted their way, they have forgotten
Yahweh their God.
22 Return, you backsliding children, and
I will heal your backsliding.
"Behold, we have come to you; for you
are Yahweh our God.
23 Truly help from the hills, the tumult
on the mountains, is in vain. Truly the
salvation of Israel is in Yahweh our God.
24 But the shameful thing has devoured
the labor of our fathers from our youth,
their flocks and their herds, their sons
and their daughters.
25 Let us lie down in our shame, and let
our confusion cover us; for we have
sinned against Yahweh our God, we and
our fathers, from our youth even to this
day. We have not obeyed Yahweh our
God's voice."

4

1 "If you will return, Israel," says
Yahweh, "if you will return to me, and if
you will put away your abominations out
of my sight; then you will not be removed;
2 and you will swear, 'As Yahweh lives,'
in truth, in justice, and in righteousness.
The nations will bless themselves in him,
and they will glory in him."

3 For Yahweh says to the men of Judah
and to Jerusalem, “Break up your fallow
ground, and don’t sow among thorns.
4 Circumcise yourselves to Yahweh, and
take away the foreskins of your heart, you
men of Judah and inhabitants of
Jerusalem; lest my wrath go out like fire,
and burn so that no one can quench it,
because of the evil of your doings.
5 Declare in Judah, and publish in
Jerusalem; and say, ‘Blow the trumpet in
the land!’ Cry aloud and say, ‘Assemble
yourselves! Let’s go into the fortified
cities!’
6 Set up a standard toward Zion. Flee for
safety! Don’t wait; for I will bring evil
from the north, and a great destruction.”

7 A lion has gone up from his thicket,
and a destroyer of nations. He is on his
way. He has gone out from his place, to
make your land desolate, that your cities
be laid waste, without inhabitant.
8 For this, clothe yourself with sackcloth,
lament and wail; for the fierce anger of
Yahweh hasn’t turned back from us.
9 “It will happen at that day,” says
Yahweh, “that the heart of the king will
perish, along with the heart of the princes.
The priests will be astonished, and the
prophets will wonder.”

10 Then I said, “Ah, Lord Yahweh! Surely
you have greatly deceived this people and
Jerusalem, saying, ‘You will have peace;’
whereas the sword reaches to the heart.”

11 At that time it will be said to this
people and to Jerusalem, “A hot wind
blows from the bare heights in the
wilderness toward the daughter of my
people, not to winnow, nor to cleanse.
12 A full wind from these will come for
me. Now I will also utter judgments
against them.”

13 Behold, he will come up as clouds,
and his chariots will be as the whirlwind.
His horses are swifter than eagles. Woe to
us! For we are ruined.
14 Jerusalem, wash your heart from
wickedness, that you may be saved. How
long will your evil thoughts lodge within
you?

15 For a voice declares from Dan, and
publishes evil from the hills of Ephraim:
16 “Tell the nations, behold, publish
against Jerusalem, ‘Watchers come from a
far country, and raise their voice against
the cities of Judah.
17 As keepers of a field, they are against
her all around, because she has been
rebellious against me,’ ” says Yahweh.
18 “Your way and your doings have
brought these things to you. This is your
wickedness, for it is bitter, for it reaches to
your heart.”

19 My anguish, my anguish! I am pained
at my very heart! My heart trembles
within me. I can’t hold my peace, because
you have heard, O my soul, the sound of
the trumpet, the alarm of war.
20 Destruction on destruction is decreed,
for the whole land is laid waste. Suddenly
my tents are destroyed, and my curtains
gone in a moment.
21 How long will I see the standard and
hear the sound of the trumpet?

22 “For my people are foolish. They don’t
know me. They are foolish children, and
they have no understanding. They are
skillful in doing evil, but they don’t know
how to do good.”
23 I saw the earth and, behold, it was
waste and void, and the heavens, and they
had no light.
24 I saw the mountains, and behold, they
trembled, and all the hills moved back
and forth.
25 I saw, and behold, there was no man,
and all the birds of the sky had fled.
26 I saw, and behold, the fruitful field
was a wilderness, and all its cities were
broken down at the presence of Yahweh,
before his fierce anger.
27 For Yahweh says, “The whole land
will be a desolation; yet I will not make a
full end.
28 For this the earth will mourn, and the
heavens above be black, because I have
spoken it. I have planned it, and I have not
repented, neither will I turn back from it.”

29 Every city flees for the noise of the
horsemen and archers. They go into the
thickets and climb up on the rocks. Every

city is forsaken, and not a man dwells therein.
30 You, when you are made desolate, what will you do? Though you clothe yourself with scarlet, though you deck yourself with ornaments of gold, though you enlarge your eyes with makeup, you make yourself beautiful in vain. Your lovers despise you. They seek your life.
31 For I have heard a voice as of a woman in travail, the anguish as of her who gives birth to her first child, the voice of the daughter of Zion, who gasps for breath, who spreads her hands, saying, "Woe is me now! For my soul faints before the murderers."

5

1 "Run back and forth through the streets of Jerusalem, and see now, and know, and seek in its wide places, if you can find a man, if there is anyone who does justly, who seeks truth, then I will pardon her.
2 Though they say, 'As Yahweh lives,' surely they swear falsely."
3 O Yahweh, don't your eyes look on truth? You have stricken them, but they were not grieved. You have consumed them, but they have refused to receive correction. They have made their faces harder than a rock. They have refused to return.
4 Then I said, "Surely these are poor. They are foolish; for they don't know Yahweh's way, nor the law of their God.
5 I will go to the great men and will speak to them, for they know the way of Yahweh, and the law of their God." But these with one accord have broken the yoke, and burst the bonds.
6 Therefore a lion out of the forest will kill them. A wolf of the evenings will destroy them. A leopard will watch against their cities. Everyone who goes out there will be torn in pieces, because their transgressions are many and their backsliding has increased.
7 "How can I pardon you? Your children have forsaken me, and sworn by what are no gods. When I had fed them to the full, they committed adultery, and assembled themselves in troops at the prostitutes' houses.
8 They were as fed horses roaming at large. Everyone neighed after his neighbor's wife.
9 Shouldn't I punish them for these things?" says Yahweh. "Shouldn't my soul be avenged on such a nation as this?

10 "Go up on her walls, and destroy, but don't make a full end. Take away her branches, for they are not Yahweh's.
11 For the house of Israel and the house of Judah have dealt very treacherously against me," says Yahweh.

12 They have denied Yahweh, and said, "It is not he. Evil won't come on us. We won't see sword or famine.
13 The prophets will become wind, and the word is not in them. Thus it will be done to them."
14 Therefore Yahweh, the God of Armies says, "Because you speak this word, behold, I will make my words in your mouth fire, and this people wood, and it will devour them.
15 Behold, I will bring a nation on you from far away, house of Israel," says Yahweh. "It is a mighty nation. It is an ancient nation, a nation whose language you don't know and don't understand what they say.
16 Their quiver is an open tomb. They are all mighty men.
17 They will eat up your harvest and your bread, which your sons and your daughters should eat. They will eat up your flocks and your herds. They will eat up your vines and your fig trees. They will beat down your fortified cities in which you trust with the sword.

18 "But even in those days," says Yahweh, "I will not make a full end of you.
19 It will happen when you say, 'Why has Yahweh our God done all these things to us?' Then you shall say to them, 'Just as you have forsaken me and served foreign gods in your land, so you will serve strangers in a land that is not yours.'

20 "Declare this in the house of Jacob, and publish it in Judah, saying,

21 ‘Hear this now, foolish people without
understanding, who have eyes, and don’t
see, who have ears, and don’t hear:
22 Don’t you fear me?’ says Yahweh;
‘Won’t you tremble at my presence, who
have placed the sand for the bound of the
sea by a perpetual decree, that it can’t
pass it? Though its waves toss themselves,
yet they can’t prevail. Though they roar,
they still can’t pass over it.’
23 “But this people has a revolting and a
rebellious heart. They have revolted and
gone.
24 They don’t say in their heart, ‘Let’s
now fear Yahweh our God, who gives rain,
both the former and the latter, in its
season, who preserves to us the appointed
weeks of the harvest.’
25 “Your iniquities have turned away
these things, and your sins have withheld
good from you.
26 For wicked men are found among my
people. They watch, as fowlers lie in wait.
They set a trap. They catch men.
27 As a cage is full of birds, so are their
houses full of deceit. Therefore they have
become great, and grew rich.
28 They have grown fat. They shine; yes,
they excel in deeds of wickedness. They
don’t plead the cause, the cause of the
fatherless, that they may prosper; and
they don’t defend the rights of the needy.
29 “Shouldn’t I punish for these things?”
says Yahweh. “Shouldn’t my soul be
avenged on such a nation as this?
30 “An astonishing and horrible thing
has happened in the land.
31 The prophets prophesy falsely, and
the priests rule by their own authority;
and my people love to have it so. What
will you do in the end of it?

6

1 “Flee for safety, you children of
Benjamin, out of the middle of Jerusalem!
Blow the trumpet in Tekoa and raise up a
signal on Beth Haccherem, for evil looks
out from the north with a great
destruction.
2 I will cut off the beautiful and delicate
one, the daughter of Zion.
3 Shepherds with their flocks will come
to her. They will pitch their tents against
her all around. They will feed everyone in
his place.”
4 “Prepare war against her! Arise! Let’s
go up at noon. Woe to us! For the day
declines, for the shadows of the evening
are stretched out.
5 Arise! Let’s go up by night, and let’s
destroy her palaces.”
6 For Yahweh of Armies said, “Cut down
trees, and cast up a mound against
Jerusalem. This is the city to be visited.
She is filled with oppression within
herself.
7 As a well produces its waters, so she
produces her wickedness. Violence and
destruction is heard in her. Sickness and
wounds are continually before me.
8 Be instructed, Jerusalem, lest my soul
be alienated from you, lest I make you a
desolation, an uninhabited land.”
9 Yahweh of Armies says, “They will
thoroughly glean the remnant of Israel
like a vine. Turn again your hand as a
grape gatherer into the baskets.”
10 To whom should I speak and testify,
that they may hear? Behold, their ear is
uncircumcised, and they can’t listen.
Behold, Yahweh’s word has become a
reproach to them. They have no delight in
it.
11 Therefore I am full of Yahweh’s
wrath. I am weary with holding it in.
“Pour it out on the children in the street,
and on the assembly of young men
together;
for even the husband with the wife will be
taken,
the aged with him who is full of days.
12 Their houses will be turned to others,
their fields and their wives together;
for I will stretch out my hand on the
inhabitants of the land, says
Yahweh.”
13 “For from their least even to their
greatest, everyone is given to
covetousness.
From the prophet even to the priest,
everyone deals falsely.
14 They have healed also the hurt of my
people superficially,

saying, ‘Peace, peace!’ when there is
no peace.
15 Were they ashamed when they had
committed abomination?
No, they were not at all ashamed,
neither could they blush.
Therefore they will fall among those who
fall.
When I visit them, they will be cast
down,” says Yahweh.
16 Yahweh says, “Stand in the ways and
see, and ask for the old paths, ‘Where is
the good way?’ and walk in it, and you
will find rest for your souls. But they said,
‘We will not walk in it.’
17 I set watchmen over you, saying,
‘Listen to the sound of the trumpet!’ But
they said, ‘We will not listen!’
18 Therefore hear, you nations, and
know, congregation, what is among them.
19 Hear, earth! Behold, I will bring evil
on this people, even the fruit of their
thoughts, because they have not listened
to my words; and as for my law, they have
rejected it.
20 To what purpose does frankincense
from Sheba come to me, and the sweet
cane from a far country? Your burnt
offerings are not acceptable, and your
sacrifices are not pleasing to me.”
21 Therefore Yahweh says, “Behold, I
will lay stumbling blocks before this
people. The fathers and the sons together
will stumble against them. The neighbor
and his friend will perish.”
22 Yahweh says, “Behold, a people comes
from the north country. A great nation
will be stirred up from the uttermost
parts of the earth.
23 They take hold of bow and spear.
They are cruel, and have no mercy. Their
voice roars like the sea, and they ride on
horses, everyone set in array, as a man to
the battle, against you, daughter of Zion.”
24 We have heard its report. Our hands
become feeble. Anguish has taken hold of
us, and pains as of a woman in labor.
25 Don’t go out into the field or walk by
the way; for the sword of the enemy and
terror are on every side.
26 Daughter of my people, clothe
yourself with sackcloth, and wallow in
ashes! Mourn, as for an only son, most
bitter lamentation, for the destroyer will
suddenly come on us.
27 “I have made you a tester of metals
and a fortress among my people, that you
may know and try their way.
28 They are all grievous rebels, going
around to slander. They are bronze and
iron. All of them deal corruptly.
29 The bellows blow fiercely. The lead is
consumed in the fire. In vain they go on
refining, for the wicked are not plucked
away.
30 Men will call them rejected silver,
because Yahweh has rejected them.”

7

1 The word that came to Jeremiah from
Yahweh, saying,
2 “Stand in the gate of Yahweh’s house,
and proclaim this word there, and say,
‘Hear Yahweh’s word, all you of Judah,
who enter in at these gates to worship
Yahweh.’ ”
3 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel
says, “Amend your ways and your doings,
and I will cause you to dwell in this place.
4 Don’t trust in lying words, saying,
‘Yahweh’s temple, Yahweh’s temple,
Yahweh’s temple, are these.’
5 For if you thoroughly amend your
ways and your doings, if you thoroughly
execute justice between a man and his
neighbor;
6 if you don’t oppress the foreigner, the
fatherless, and the widow, and don’t shed
innocent blood in this place, and don’t
walk after other gods to your own hurt,
7 then I will cause you to dwell in this
place, in the land that I gave to your
fathers, from of old even forever more.
8 Behold, you trust in lying words that
can’t profit.
9 Will you steal, murder, commit
adultery, swear falsely, burn incense to
Baal, and walk after other gods that you
have not known,
10 then come and stand before me in
this house, which is called by my name,

and say, 'We are delivered,' that you may do all these abominations?
11 Has this house, which is called by my name, become a den of robbers in your eyes? Behold, I myself have seen it," says Yahweh.
12 "But go now to my place which was in Shiloh, where I caused my name to dwell at the first, and see what I did to it for the wickedness of my people Israel.
13 Now, because you have done all these works," says Yahweh, "and I spoke to you, rising up early and speaking, but you didn't hear; and I called you, but you didn't answer;
14 therefore I will do to the house which is called by my name, in which you trust, and to the place which I gave to you and to your fathers, as I did to Shiloh.
15 I will cast you out of my sight, as I have cast out all your brothers, even the whole offspring† of Ephraim.
16 "Therefore don't pray for this people. Don't lift up a cry or prayer for them or make intercession to me; for I will not hear you.
17 Don't you see what they do in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem?
18 The children gather wood, and the fathers kindle the fire, and the women knead the dough, to make cakes to the queen of the sky, and to pour out drink offerings to other gods, that they may provoke me to anger.
19 Do they provoke me to anger?" says Yahweh. "Don't they provoke themselves, to the confusion of their own faces?"
20 Therefore the Lord Yahweh says: "Behold, my anger and my wrath will be poured out on this place, on man, on animal, on the trees of the field, and on the fruit of the ground; and it will burn and will not be quenched."
21 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says: "Add your burnt offerings to your sacrifices and eat meat.
22 For I didn't speak to your fathers or command them in the day that I brought them out of the land of Egypt concerning burnt offerings or sacrifices;
23 but this thing I commanded them, saying, 'Listen to my voice, and I will be your God, and you shall be my people. Walk in all the way that I command you, that it may be well with you.'
24 But they didn't listen or turn their ear, but walked in their own counsels and in the stubbornness of their evil heart, and went backward, and not forward.
25 Since the day that your fathers came out of the land of Egypt to this day, I have sent to you all my servants the prophets, daily rising up early and sending them.
26 Yet they didn't listen to me or incline their ear, but made their neck stiff. They did worse than their fathers.
27 "You shall speak all these words to them, but they will not listen to you. You shall also call to them, but they will not answer you.
28 You shall tell them, 'This is the nation that has not listened to Yahweh their God's voice, nor received instruction. Truth has perished, and is cut off from their mouth.'
29 Cut off your hair, and throw it away, and take up a lamentation on the bare heights; for Yahweh has rejected and forsaken the generation of his wrath.
30 "For the children of Judah have done that which is evil in my sight," says Yahweh. "They have set their abominations in the house which is called by my name, to defile it.
31 They have built the high places of Topheth, which is in the valley of the son of Hinnom, to burn their sons and their daughters in the fire, which I didn't command, nor did it come into my mind.
32 Therefore behold, the days come", says Yahweh, "that it will no more be called 'Topheth' or 'The valley of the son of Hinnom', but 'The valley of Slaughter'; for they will bury in Topheth until there is no place to bury.
33 The dead bodies of this people will be food for the birds of the sky, and for the animals of the earth. No one will frighten them away.

† **7:15** or, seed

34 Then I will cause to cease from the
cities of Judah and from the streets of
Jerusalem the voice of mirth and the voice
of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom
and the voice of the bride; for the land
will become a waste."

8

1 "At that time," says Yahweh, "they will
bring the bones of the kings of Judah, the
bones of his princes, the bones of the
priests, the bones of the prophets, and the
bones of the inhabitants of Jerusalem, out
of their graves.
2 They will spread them before the sun,
the moon, and all the army of the sky,
which they have loved, which they have
served, after which they have walked,
which they have sought, and which they
have worshiped. They will not be
gathered or be buried. They will be like
dung on the surface of the earth.
3 Death will be chosen rather than life
by all the residue that remain of this evil
family, that remain in all the places where
I have driven them," says Yahweh of
Armies.
4 "Moreover you shall tell them,
'Yahweh says:

" 'Do men fall, and not rise up again?
Does one turn away, and not return?
5 Why then have the people of Jerusalem
fallen back by a perpetual
backsliding?
They cling to deceit.
They refuse to return.
6 I listened and heard, but they didn't say
what is right.
No one repents of his wickedness,
saying, "What have I done?"
Everyone turns to his course,
as a horse that rushes headlong in the
battle.
7 Yes, the stork in the sky knows her
appointed times.
The turtledove, the swallow, and the
crane observe the time of their
coming;
but my people don't know Yahweh's
law.
8 " 'How do you say, "We are wise, and
Yahweh's law is with us"?
But, behold, the false pen of the
scribes has made that a lie.
9 The wise men are disappointed.
They are dismayed and trapped.
Behold, they have rejected Yahweh's
word.
What kind of wisdom is in them?
10 Therefore I will give their wives to
others
and their fields to those who will
possess them.
For everyone from the least even to the
greatest is given to covetousness;
from the prophet even to the priest
everyone deals falsely.
11 They have healed the hurt of the
daughter of my people slightly,
saying,
"Peace, peace," when there is no
peace.
12 Were they ashamed when they had
committed abomination?
No, they were not at all ashamed.
They couldn't blush.
Therefore they will fall among those who
fall.
In the time of their visitation they will
be cast down, says Yahweh.

13 " 'I will utterly consume them, says
Yahweh.
No grapes will be on the vine,
no figs on the fig tree,
and the leaf will fade.
The things that I have given them
will pass away from them.' "

14 "Why do we sit still?
Assemble yourselves!
Let's enter into the fortified cities,
and let's be silent there;
for Yahweh our God has put us to silence,
and given us poisoned water to drink,
because we have sinned against
Yahweh.
15 We looked for peace, but no good came;
and for a time of healing, and behold,
dismay!
16 The snorting of his horses is heard from
Dan.

The whole land trembles at the sound
of the neighing of his strong ones;
for they have come, and have devoured
the land and all that is in it,
the city and those who dwell therein."
17 "For, behold, I will send serpents,
adders among you,
which will not be charmed;
and they will bite you," says Yahweh.
18 Oh that I could comfort myself against
sorrow!
My heart is faint within me.
19 Behold, the voice of the cry of the
daughter of my people from a land
that is very far off:
"Isn't Yahweh in Zion?
Isn't her King in her?"

"Why have they provoked me to anger
with their engraved images,
and with foreign idols?"

20 "The harvest is past.
The summer has ended,
and we are not saved."

21 For the hurt of the daughter of my
people, I am hurt.
I mourn.
Dismay has taken hold of me.
22 Is there no balm in Gilead?
Is there no physician there?
Why then isn't the health of the daughter
of my people recovered?

9

1 Oh that my head were waters,
and my eyes a spring of tears,
that I might weep day and night
for the slain of the daughter of my
people!
2 Oh that I had in the wilderness
a lodging place of wayfaring men,
that I might leave my people
and go from them!
For they are all adulterers,
an assembly of treacherous men.
3 "They bend their tongue,
as their bow, for falsehood.
They have grown strong in the land,
but not for truth;
for they proceed from evil to evil,
and they don't know me," says
Yahweh.
4 "Everyone beware of his neighbor,
and don't trust in any brother;
for every brother will utterly supplant,
and every neighbor will go around
like a slanderer.
5 Friends deceive each other,
and will not speak the truth.
They have taught their tongue to speak
lies.
They weary themselves committing
iniquity.
6 Your habitation is in the middle of deceit.
Through deceit, they refuse to know
me," says Yahweh.
7 Therefore Yahweh of Armies says,
"Behold, I will melt them and test them;
for how should I deal with the
daughter of my people?
8 Their tongue is a deadly arrow.
It speaks deceit.
One speaks peaceably to his neighbor
with his mouth,
but in his heart, he waits to ambush
him.
9 Shouldn't I punish them for these
things?" says Yahweh.
"Shouldn't my soul be avenged on a
nation such as this?
10 I will weep and wail for the mountains,
and lament for the pastures of the
wilderness,
because they are burned up, so that no
one passes through;
Men can't hear the voice of the
livestock.
Both the birds of the sky and the animals
have fled.
They are gone.

11 "I will make Jerusalem heaps,
a dwelling place of jackals.
I will make the cities of Judah a desolation,
without inhabitant."
12 Who is wise enough to understand
this? Who is he to whom the mouth of
Yahweh has spoken, that he may declare
it? Why has the land perished and burned
up like a wilderness, so that no one passes
through?
13 Yahweh says, "Because they have
forsaken my law which I set before them,

and have not obeyed my voice or walked
in my ways,
14 but have walked after the
stubbornness of their own heart and after
the Baals, which their fathers taught
them."
15 Therefore Yahweh of Armies, the God
of Israel, says, "Behold, I will feed them,
even this people, with wormwood and
give them poisoned water to drink.
16 I will scatter them also among the
nations, whom neither they nor their
fathers have known. I will send the sword
after them, until I have consumed them."
17 Yahweh of Armies says,
"Consider, and call for the mourning
women, that they may come.
Send for the skillful women, that they
may come.
18 Let them make haste
and take up a wailing for us,
that our eyes may run down with tears
and our eyelids gush out with waters.
19 For a voice of wailing is heard out of
Zion,
'How we are ruined!
We are greatly confounded
because we have forsaken the land,
because they have cast down our
dwellings.' "

20 Yet hear Yahweh's word, you women.
Let your ear receive the word of his
mouth.
Teach your daughters wailing.
Everyone teach her neighbor a
lamentation.
21 For death has come up into our
windows.
It has entered into our palaces
to cut off the children from outside,
and the young men from the streets.
22 Speak, "Yahweh says,
" 'The dead bodies of men will fall as dung
on the open field,
and as the handful after the
harvester.
No one will gather them.' "
23 Yahweh says,
"Don't let the wise man glory in his
wisdom.
Don't let the mighty man glory in his
might.
Don't let the rich man glory in his
riches.
24 But let him who glories glory in this,
that he has understanding, and
knows me,
that I am Yahweh who exercises loving
kindness, justice, and
righteousness in the earth,
for I delight in these things," says
Yahweh.
25 "Behold, the days come," says
Yahweh, "that I will punish all those who
are circumcised only in their flesh:
26 Egypt, Judah, Edom, the children of
Ammon, Moab, and all who have the
corners of their hair cut off, who dwell in
the wilderness, for all the nations are
uncircumcised, and all the house of Israel
are uncircumcised in heart."

10

1 Hear the word which Yahweh speaks
to you, house of Israel!
2 Yahweh says,
"Don't learn the way of the nations,
and don't be dismayed at the signs of
the sky;
for the nations are dismayed at them.
3 For the customs of the peoples are
vanity;
for one cuts a tree out of the forest,
the work of the hands of the
workman with the ax.
4 They deck it with silver and with gold.
They fasten it with nails and with
hammers,
so that it can't move.
5 They are like a palm tree, of turned work,
and don't speak.
They must be carried,
because they can't move.
Don't be afraid of them;
for they can't do evil,
neither is it in them to do good."
6 There is no one like you, Yahweh.
You are great,
and your name is great in might.
7 Who shouldn't fear you,
King of the nations?
For it belongs to you.
Because among all the wise men of the
nations,

and in all their royal estate,
there is no one like you.
8 But they are together brutish and foolish,
instructed by idols!
It is just wood.
9 There is silver beaten into plates, which is brought from Tarshish,
and gold from Uphaz,
the work of the engraver and of the hands of the goldsmith.
Their clothing is blue and purple.
They are all the work of skillful men.
10 But Yahweh is the true God.
He is the living God,
and an everlasting King.
At his wrath, the earth trembles.
The nations aren't able to withstand his indignation.
11 "You shall say this to them: 'The gods that have not made the heavens and the earth will perish from the earth, and from under the heavens.' "
12 God has made the earth by his power.
He has established the world by his wisdom,
and by his understanding has he stretched out the heavens.
13 When he utters his voice,
the waters in the heavens roar,
and he causes the vapors to ascend from the ends of the earth.
He makes lightnings for the rain,
and brings the wind out of his treasuries.
14 Every man has become brutish and without knowledge.
Every goldsmith is disappointed by his engraved image;
for his molten image is falsehood,
and there is no breath in them.
15 They are vanity, a work of delusion.
In the time of their visitation they will perish.
16 The portion of Jacob is not like these;
for he is the maker of all things;
and Israel is the tribe of his inheritance.
Yahweh of Armies is his name.
17 Gather up your wares out of the land,
you who live under siege.
18 For Yahweh says,
"Behold, I will sling out the inhabitants of the land at this time,
and will distress them, that they may feel it."
19 Woe is me because of my injury!
My wound is serious;
but I said,
"Truly this is my grief, and I must bear it."
20 My tent has been destroyed,
and all my cords are broken.
My children have gone away from me, and they are no more.
There is no one to spread my tent any more,
to set up my curtains.
21 For the shepherds have become brutish,
and have not inquired of Yahweh.
Therefore they have not prospered,
and all their flocks have scattered.
22 The voice of news, behold, it comes,
and a great commotion out of the north country,
to make the cities of Judah a desolation,
a dwelling place of jackals.
23 Yahweh, I know that the way of man is not in himself.
It is not in man who walks to direct his steps.
24 Yahweh, correct me, but gently;
not in your anger,
lest you reduce me to nothing.
25 Pour out your wrath on the nations that don't know you,
and on the families that don't call on your name;
for they have devoured Jacob.
Yes, they have devoured him, consumed him,
and have laid waste his habitation.

11

1 The word that came to Jeremiah from Yahweh, saying,
2 "Hear the words of this covenant, and speak to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem;
3 and say to them, Yahweh, the God of Israel says: 'Cursed is the man who doesn't hear the words of this covenant,
4 which I commanded your fathers in the day that I brought them out of the land of Egypt, out of the iron furnace,' saying, 'Obey my voice and do them, according to

all which I command you; so you shall be
my people, and I will be your God;
5 that I may establish the oath which I
swore to your fathers, to give them a land
flowing with milk and honey,' as it is
today."
Then I answered, and said, "Amen,
Yahweh."
6 Yahweh said to me, "Proclaim all these
words in the cities of Judah, and in the
streets of Jerusalem, saying, 'Hear the
words of this covenant, and do them.
7 For I earnestly protested to your
fathers in the day that I brought them up
out of the land of Egypt, even to this day,
rising early and protesting, saying, "Obey
my voice."
8 Yet they didn't obey, nor turn their ear,
but everyone walked in the stubbornness
of their evil heart. Therefore I brought on
them all the words of this covenant,
which I commanded them to do, but they
didn't do them.' "
9 Yahweh said to me, "A conspiracy is
found among the men of Judah, and
among the inhabitants of Jerusalem.
10 They have turned back to the
iniquities of their forefathers, who
refused to hear my words. They have
gone after other gods to serve them. The
house of Israel and the house of Judah
have broken my covenant which I made
with their fathers.
11 Therefore Yahweh says, 'Behold, I will
bring evil on them which they will not be
able to escape; and they will cry to me, but
I will not listen to them.
12 Then the cities of Judah and the
inhabitants of Jerusalem will go and cry to
the gods to which they offer incense, but
they will not save them at all in the time of
their trouble.
13 For according to the number of your
cities are your gods, Judah; and according
to the number of the streets of Jerusalem
you have set up altars to the shameful
thing, even altars to burn incense to Baal.'
14 "Therefore don't pray for this people.
Don't lift up cry or prayer for them; for I
will not hear them in the time that they
cry to me because of their trouble.
15 What has my beloved to do in my house,
since she has behaved lewdly with
many,
and the holy flesh has passed from
you?
When you do evil,
then you rejoice."

16 Yahweh called your name, "A green
olive tree,
beautiful with goodly fruit."
With the noise of a great roar he has
kindled fire on it,
and its branches are broken.
17 For Yahweh of Armies, who planted
you, has pronounced evil against you,
because of the evil of the house of Israel
and of the house of Judah, which they
have done to themselves in provoking me
to anger by offering incense to Baal.
18 Yahweh gave me knowledge of it, and
I knew it. Then you showed me their
doings.
19 But I was like a gentle lamb that is led
to the slaughter. I didn't know that they
had devised plans against me, saying,
"Let's destroy the tree with its fruit,
and let's cut him off from the land of
the living,
that his name may be no more
remembered."
20 But, Yahweh of Armies, who judges
righteously,
who tests the heart and the mind,
I will see your vengeance on them;
for to you I have revealed my cause.
21 "Therefore Yahweh says concerning
the men of Anathoth, who seek your life,
saying, 'You shall not prophesy in
Yahweh's name, that you not die by our
hand'—
22 therefore Yahweh of Armies says,
'Behold, I will punish them. The young
men will die by the sword. Their sons and
their daughters will die by famine.
23 There will be no remnant to them, for
I will bring evil on the men of Anathoth,
even the year of their visitation.' "

12

1 You are righteous, Yahweh,
when I contend with you;

yet I would like to plead a case with you.
Why does the way of the wicked prosper?
Why are they all at ease who deal very treacherously?
2 You have planted them. Yes, they have taken root.
They grow. Yes, they produce fruit.
You are near in their mouth,
and far from their heart.
3 But you, Yahweh, know me.
You see me, and test my heart toward you.
Pull them out like sheep for the slaughter,
and prepare them for the day of slaughter.
4 How long will the land mourn,
and the herbs of the whole country wither?
Because of the wickedness of those who dwell therein,
the animals and birds are consumed;
because they said,
"He won't see our latter end."
5 "If you have run with the footmen,
and they have wearied you,
then how can you contend with horses?
Though in a land of peace you are secure,
yet how will you do in the pride of the Jordan?
6 For even your brothers, and the house of your father,
even they have dealt treacherously with you!
Even they have cried aloud after you!
Don't believe them,
though they speak beautiful words to you.

7 "I have forsaken my house.
I have cast off my heritage.
I have given the dearly beloved of my soul into the hand of her enemies.
8 My heritage has become to me as a lion in the forest.
She has uttered her voice against me.
Therefore I have hated her.
9 Is my heritage to me as a speckled bird of prey?
Are the birds of prey against her all around?
Go, assemble all the animals of the field.
Bring them to devour.
10 Many shepherds have destroyed my vineyard.
They have trodden my portion under foot.
They have made my pleasant portion a desolate wilderness.
11 They have made it a desolation.
It mourns to me, being desolate.
The whole land is made desolate,
because no one cares.
12 Destroyers have come on all the bare heights in the wilderness;
for the sword of Yahweh devours from the one end of the land even to the other end of the land.
No flesh has peace.
13 They have sown wheat,
and have reaped thorns.
They have exhausted themselves,
and profit nothing.
You will be ashamed of your fruits,
because of Yahweh's fierce anger."

14 Yahweh says, "Concerning all my evil neighbors, who touch the inheritance which I have caused my people Israel to inherit: Behold, I will pluck them up from off their land, and will pluck up the house of Judah from among them.
15 It will happen that after I have plucked them up, I will return and have compassion on them. I will bring them again, every man to his heritage, and every man to his land.
16 It will happen, if they will diligently learn the ways of my people, to swear by my name, 'As Yahweh lives;' even as they taught my people to swear by Baal, then they will be built up in the middle of my people.
17 But if they will not hear, then I will pluck up that nation, plucking up and destroying it," says Yahweh.

13

1 Yahweh said to me, "Go, and buy yourself a linen belt, and put it on your waist, and don't put it in water."
2 So I bought a belt according to Yahweh's word, and put it on my waist.

3 Yahweh's word came to me the second time, saying,
4 "Take the belt that you have bought, which is on your waist, and arise, go to the Euphrates, and hide it there in a cleft of the rock."
5 So I went and hid it by the Euphrates, as Yahweh commanded me.
6 After many days, Yahweh said to me, "Arise, go to the Euphrates, and take the belt from there, which I commanded you to hide there."
7 Then I went to the Euphrates, and dug, and took the belt from the place where I had hidden it; and behold, the belt was ruined. It was profitable for nothing.
8 Then Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
9 "Yahweh says, 'In this way I will ruin the pride of Judah, and the great pride of Jerusalem.
10 This evil people, who refuse to hear my words, who walk in the stubbornness of their heart, and have gone after other gods to serve them and to worship them, will even be as this belt, which is profitable for nothing.
11 For as the belt clings to the waist of a man, so I have caused the whole house of Israel and the whole house of Judah to cling to me,' says Yahweh; 'that they may be to me for a people, for a name, for praise, and for glory; but they would not hear.'
12 "Therefore you shall speak to them this word: 'Yahweh, the God of Israel says, "Every container should be filled with wine." ' They will tell you, 'Do we not certainly know that every container should be filled with wine?'
13 Then tell them, 'Yahweh says, "Behold, I will fill all the inhabitants of this land, even the kings who sit on David's throne, the priests, the prophets, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, with drunkenness.
14 I will dash them one against another, even the fathers and the sons together," says Yahweh: "I will not pity, spare, or have compassion, that I should not destroy them." ' "
15 Hear, and give ear.
Don't be proud,
for Yahweh has spoken.
16 Give glory to Yahweh your God,
before he causes darkness,
and before your feet stumble on the dark mountains,
and while you look for light,
he turns it into the shadow of death,
and makes it deep darkness.
17 But if you will not hear it,
my soul will weep in secret for your pride.
My eye will weep bitterly,
and run down with tears,
because Yahweh's flock has been taken captive.
18 Say to the king and to the queen mother,
"Humble yourselves.
Sit down, for your crowns have come down,
even the crown of your glory.
19 The cities of the South are shut up,
and there is no one to open them.
Judah is carried away captive: all of them.
They are wholly carried away captive.
20 Lift up your eyes,
and see those who come from the north.
Where is the flock that was given to you,
your beautiful flock?
21 What will you say when he sets over you as head those whom you have yourself taught to be friends to you?
Won't sorrows take hold of you, as of a woman in travail?
22 If you say in your heart,
"Why have these things come on me?"
Your skirts are uncovered because of the greatness of your iniquity,
and your heels suffer violence.
23 Can the Ethiopian change his skin,
or the leopard his spots?
Then may you also do good,
who are accustomed to do evil.

24 "Therefore I will scatter them
as the stubble that passes away
by the wind of the wilderness.
25 This is your lot,
the portion measured to you from me," says Yahweh,
"because you have forgotten me,

and trusted in falsehood.”
26 Therefore I will also uncover your skirts
on your face,
and your shame will appear.
27 I have seen your abominations, even
your adulteries
and your neighing, the lewdness of
your prostitution,
on the hills in the field.
Woe to you, Jerusalem!
You will not be made clean.
How long will it yet be?”

14

1 This is Yahweh’s word that came to
Jeremiah concerning the drought:
2 “Judah mourns,
and its gates languish.
They sit in black on the ground.
The cry of Jerusalem goes up.
3 Their nobles send their little ones to the
waters.
They come to the cisterns,
and find no water.
They return with their vessels empty.
They are disappointed and
confounded,
and cover their heads.
4 Because of the ground which is cracked,
because no rain has been in the land,
the plowmen are disappointed.
They cover their heads.
5 Yes, the doe in the field also calves and
forsakes her young,
because there is no grass.
6 The wild donkeys stand on the bare
heights.
They pant for air like jackals.
Their eyes fail,
because there is no vegetation.
7 Though our iniquities testify against us,
work for your name’s sake, Yahweh;
for our rebellions are many.
We have sinned against you.
8 You hope of Israel,
its Savior in the time of trouble,
why should you be as a foreigner in the
land,
and as a wayfaring man who turns
aside to stay for a night?
9 Why should you be like a scared man,
as a mighty man who can’t save?
Yet you, Yahweh, are in the middle of us,
and we are called by your name.
Don’t leave us.
10 Yahweh says to this people:
“Even so they have loved to wander.
They have not restrained their feet.
Therefore Yahweh does not accept them.
Now he will remember their iniquity,
and punish them for their sins.”
11 Yahweh said to me, “Don’t pray for
this people for their good.
12 When they fast, I will not hear their
cry; and when they offer burnt offering
and meal offering, I will not accept them;
but I will consume them by the sword, by
famine, and by pestilence.”
13 Then I said, “Ah, Lord Yahweh!
Behold, the prophets tell them, ‘You will
not see the sword, neither will you have
famine; but I will give you assured peace
in this place.’ ”
14 Then Yahweh said to me, “The
prophets prophesy lies in my name. I
didn’t send them. I didn’t command them.
I didn’t speak to them. They prophesy to
you a lying vision, divination, and a thing
of nothing, and the deceit of their own
heart.
15 Therefore Yahweh says concerning
the prophets who prophesy in my name,
but I didn’t send them, yet they say,
‘Sword and famine will not be in this
land.’ Those prophets will be consumed
by sword and famine.
16 The people to whom they prophesy
will be cast out in the streets of Jerusalem
because of the famine and the sword.
They will have no one to bury
them—them, their wives, their sons, or
their daughters, for I will pour their
wickedness on them.
17 “You shall say this word to them:
“ ‘Let my eyes run down with tears night
and day,
and let them not cease;
for the virgin daughter of my people is
broken with a great breach,
with a very grievous wound.
18 If I go out into the field,
then behold, the slain with the sword!
If I enter into the city,

then behold, those who are sick with famine!
For both the prophet and the priest go about in the land,
and have no knowledge.' "

19 Have you utterly rejected Judah?
Has your soul loathed Zion?
Why have you struck us, and there is no healing for us?
We looked for peace, but no good came;
and for a time of healing, and behold, dismay!
20 We acknowledge, Yahweh, our wickedness,
and the iniquity of our fathers;
for we have sinned against you.
21 Do not abhor us, for your name's sake.
Do not disgrace the throne of your glory.
Remember, and don't break your covenant with us.
22 Are there any among the vanities of the nations that can cause rain?
Or can the sky give showers?
Aren't you he, Yahweh our God?
Therefore we will wait for you;
for you have made all these things.

15

1 Then Yahweh said to me, "Though Moses and Samuel stood before me, yet my mind would not turn toward this people. Cast them out of my sight, and let them go out!
2 It will happen when they ask you, 'Where shall we go out?' then you shall tell them, 'Yahweh says:
"Such as are for death, to death;
such as are for the sword, to the sword;
such as are for the famine, to the famine;
and such as are for captivity, to captivity." '
3 "I will appoint over them four kinds," says Yahweh: "the sword to kill, the dogs to tear, the birds of the sky, and the animals of the earth, to devour and to destroy.
4 I will cause them to be tossed back and forth among all the kingdoms of the earth, because of Manasseh, the son of Hezekiah, king of Judah, for that which he did in Jerusalem.
5 For who will have pity on you, Jerusalem?
Who will mourn you?
Who will come to ask of your welfare?
6 You have rejected me," says Yahweh.
"You have gone backward.
Therefore I have stretched out my hand against you
and destroyed you.
I am weary of showing compassion.
7 I have winnowed them with a fan in the gates of the land.
I have bereaved them of children.
I have destroyed my people.
They didn't return from their ways.
8 Their widows are increased more than the sand of the seas.
I have brought on them against the mother of the young men a destroyer at noonday.
I have caused anguish and terrors to fall on her suddenly.
9 She who has borne seven languishes.
She has given up the spirit.
Her sun has gone down while it was yet day.
She has been disappointed and confounded.
I will deliver their residue to the sword before their enemies," says Yahweh.

10 Woe is me, my mother, that you have borne me, a man of strife,
and a man of contention to the whole earth!
I have not lent, neither have men lent to me;
yet every one of them curses me.
11 Yahweh said,
"Most certainly I will strengthen you for good.
Most certainly I will cause the enemy to make supplication to you in the time of evil
and in the time of affliction.
12 Can one break iron,
even iron from the north, and bronze?

13 I will give your substance and your
treasures for a plunder without
price,
and that for all your sins,
even in all your borders.
14 I will make them to pass with your
enemies into a land which you
don't know;
for a fire is kindled in my anger,
which will burn on you."

15 Yahweh, you know.
Remember me, visit me,
and avenge me of my persecutors.
You are patient, so don't take me away.
Know that for your sake I have
suffered reproach.
16 Your words were found,
and I ate them.
Your words were to me a joy and the
rejoicing of my heart,
for I am called by your name,
Yahweh, God of Armies.
17 I didn't sit in the assembly of those who
make merry and rejoice.
I sat alone because of your hand,
for you have filled me with
indignation.
18 Why is my pain perpetual,
and my wound incurable,
which refuses to be healed?
Will you indeed be to me as a deceitful
brook,
like waters that fail?
19 Therefore Yahweh says,
"If you return, then I will bring you again,
that you may stand before me;
and if you take out the precious from the
vile,
you will be as my mouth.
They will return to you,
but you will not return to them.
20 I will make you to this people a fortified
bronze wall.
They will fight against you,
but they will not prevail against you;
for I am with you to save you
and to deliver you," says Yahweh.
21 "I will deliver you out of the hand of the
wicked,
and I will redeem you out of the hand
of the terrible."

16

1 Then Yahweh's word came to me,
saying,
2 "You shall not take a wife, neither shall
you have sons or daughters, in this place."
3 For Yahweh says concerning the sons
and concerning the daughters who are
born in this place, and concerning their
mothers who bore them, and concerning
their fathers who became their father in
this land:
4 "They will die grievous deaths. They
will not be lamented, neither will they be
buried. They will be as dung on the
surface of the ground. They will be
consumed by the sword and by famine.
Their dead bodies will be food for the
birds of the sky and for the animals of the
earth."
5 For Yahweh says, "Don't enter into the
house of mourning. Don't go to lament.
Don't bemoan them, for I have taken
away my peace from this people," says
Yahweh, "even loving kindness and
tender mercies.
6 Both great and small will die in this
land. They will not be buried. Men won't
lament for them, cut themselves, or make
themselves bald for them.
7 Men won't break bread for them in
mourning, to comfort them for the dead.
Men won't give them the cup of
consolation to drink for their father or for
their mother.
8 "You shall not go into the house of
feasting to sit with them, to eat and to
drink."
9 For Yahweh of Armies, the God of
Israel says: "Behold, I will cause to cease
out of this place, before your eyes and in
your days, the voice of mirth and the
voice of gladness, the voice of the
bridegroom and the voice of the bride.
10 It will happen, when you tell this
people all these words, and they ask you,
'Why has Yahweh pronounced all this
great evil against us?' or 'What is our
iniquity?' or 'What is our sin that we have
committed against Yahweh our God?'
11 then you shall tell them, 'Because
your fathers have forsaken me,' says
Yahweh, 'and have walked after other

gods, have served them, have worshiped them, have forsaken me, and have not kept my law.
12 You have done evil more than your fathers, for behold, you each walk after the stubbornness of his evil heart, so that you don't listen to me.
13 Therefore I will cast you out of this land into the land that you have not known, neither you nor your fathers. There you will serve other gods day and night, for I will show you no favor.'
14 "Therefore behold, the days come," says Yahweh, "that it will no more be said, 'As Yahweh lives, who brought up the children of Israel out of the land of Egypt;'
15 but, 'As Yahweh lives, who brought up the children of Israel from the land of the north, and from all the countries where he had driven them.' I will bring them again into their land that I gave to their fathers.
16 "Behold, I will send for many fishermen," says Yahweh, "and they will fish them up. Afterward I will send for many hunters, and they will hunt them from every mountain, from every hill, and out of the clefts of the rocks.
17 For my eyes are on all their ways. They are not hidden from my face. Their iniquity isn't concealed from my eyes.
18 First I will recompense their iniquity and their sin double, because they have polluted my land with the carcasses of their detestable things, and have filled my inheritance with their abominations."

19 Yahweh, my strength, my stronghold,
and my refuge in the day of affliction,
the nations will come to you from the ends of the earth,
and will say,
"Our fathers have inherited nothing but lies,
vanity and things in which there is no profit.
20 Should a man make to himself gods
which yet are no gods?"

21 "Therefore behold, I will cause them to know,
this once I will cause them to know my hand and my might.
Then they will know that my name is Yahweh."

17

1 "The sin of Judah is written with a pen of iron,
and with the point of a diamond.
It is engraved on the tablet of their heart,
and on the horns of your altars.
2 Even their children remember their altars
and their Asherah poles by the green trees on the high hills.
3 My mountain in the field,
I will give your substance and all your treasures for a plunder,
and your high places, because of sin, throughout all your borders.
4 You, even of yourself, will discontinue from your heritage that I gave you.
I will cause you to serve your enemies in the land which you don't know,
for you have kindled a fire in my anger which will burn forever."
5 Yahweh says:
"Cursed is the man who trusts in man,
relies on strength of flesh,
and whose heart departs from Yahweh.
6 For he will be like a bush in the desert,
and will not see when good comes,
but will inhabit the parched places in the wilderness,
an uninhabited salt land.

7 "Blessed is the man who trusts in Yahweh,
and whose confidence is in Yahweh.
8 For he will be as a tree planted by the waters,
who spreads out its roots by the river,
and will not fear when heat comes,
but its leaf will be green,
and will not be concerned in the year of drought.
It won't cease from yielding fruit.
9 The heart is deceitful above all things
and it is exceedingly corrupt.
Who can know it?

10 "I, Yahweh, search the mind.

I try the heart,
even to give every man according to his ways,
according to the fruit of his doings."

11 As the partridge that sits on eggs which she has not laid,
so is he who gets riches, and not by right.
In the middle of his days, they will leave him.
At his end, he will be a fool.
12 A glorious throne, set on high from the beginning,
is the place of our sanctuary.
13 Yahweh, the hope of Israel,
all who forsake you will be disappointed.
Those who depart from me will be written in the earth,
because they have forsaken Yahweh,
the spring of living waters.
14 Heal me, O Yahweh, and I will be healed.
Save me, and I will be saved;
for you are my praise.
15 Behold, they ask me,
"Where is Yahweh's word?
Let it be fulfilled now."
16 As for me, I have not hurried from being a shepherd after you.
I haven't desired the woeful day. You know.
That which came out of my lips was before your face.
17 Don't be a terror to me.
You are my refuge in the day of evil.
18 Let them be disappointed who persecute me,
but don't let me be disappointed.
Let them be dismayed,
but don't let me be dismayed.
Bring on them the day of evil,
and destroy them with double destruction.
19 Yahweh said this to me: "Go and stand in the gate of the children of the people, through which the kings of Judah come in and by which they go out, and in all the gates of Jerusalem.
20 Tell them, 'Hear Yahweh's word, you kings of Judah, all Judah, and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem, that enter in by these gates:
21 Yahweh says, "Be careful, and bear no burden on the Sabbath day, nor bring it in by the gates of Jerusalem.
22 Don't carry a burden out of your houses on the Sabbath day. Don't do any work, but make the Sabbath day holy, as I commanded your fathers.
23 But they didn't listen. They didn't turn their ear, but made their neck stiff, that they might not hear, and might not receive instruction.
24 It will happen, if you diligently listen to me," says Yahweh, "to bring in no burden through the gates of this city on the Sabbath day, but to make the Sabbath day holy, to do no work therein;
25 then there will enter in by the gates of this city kings and princes sitting on David's throne, riding in chariots and on horses, they and their princes, the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem; and this city will remain forever.
26 They will come from the cities of Judah, and from the places around Jerusalem, from the land of Benjamin, from the lowland, from the hill country, and from the South, bringing burnt offerings, sacrifices, meal offerings, and frankincense, and bringing sacrifices of thanksgiving to Yahweh's house.
27 But if you will not listen to me to make the Sabbath day holy, and not to bear a burden and enter in at the gates of Jerusalem on the Sabbath day, then I will kindle a fire in its gates, and it will devour the palaces of Jerusalem. It will not be quenched." ' "

18

1 The word which came to Jeremiah from Yahweh, saying,
2 "Arise, and go down to the potter's house, and there I will cause you to hear my words."
3 Then I went down to the potter's house, and behold, he was making something on the wheels.
4 When the vessel that he made of the clay was marred in the hand of the potter,

he made it again another vessel, as
seemed good to the potter to make it.
5 Then Yahweh's word came to me,
saying,
6 "House of Israel, can't I do with you as
this potter?" says Yahweh. "Behold, as the
clay in the potter's hand, so are you in my
hand, house of Israel.
7 At the instant I speak concerning a
nation, and concerning a kingdom, to
pluck up and to break down and to
destroy it,
8 if that nation, concerning which I have
spoken, turns from their evil, I will repent
of the evil that I thought to do to them.
9 At the instant I speak concerning a
nation, and concerning a kingdom, to
build and to plant it,
10 if they do that which is evil in my
sight, that they don't obey my voice, then I
will repent of the good with which I said I
would benefit them.
11 "Now therefore, speak to the men of
Judah, and to the inhabitants of
Jerusalem, saying, 'Yahweh says: "Behold,
I frame evil against you, and devise a plan
against you. Everyone return from his
evil way now, and amend your ways and
your doings." '
12 But they say, 'It is in vain; for we will
walk after our own plans, and we will
each follow the stubbornness of his evil
heart.' "
13 Therefore Yahweh says:
"Ask now among the nations,
'Who has heard such things?'
The virgin of Israel has done a very
horrible thing.
14 Will the snow of Lebanon fail from the
rock of the field?
Will the cold waters that flow down
from afar be dried up?
15 For my people have forgotten me.
They have burned incense to false
gods.
They have been made to stumble in their
ways
in the ancient paths,
to walk in byways, in a way not built
up,
16 to make their land an astonishment,
and a perpetual hissing.
Everyone who passes by it will be
astonished,
and shake his head.
17 I will scatter them as with an east wind
before the enemy.
I will show them the back, and not the
face,
in the day of their calamity.
18 Then they said, "Come! Let's devise
plans against Jeremiah; for the law won't
perish from the priest, nor counsel from
the wise, nor the word from the prophet.
Come, and let's strike him with the
tongue, and let's not give heed to any of
his words."
19 Give heed to me, Yahweh,
and listen to the voice of those who
contend with me.
20 Should evil be recompensed for good?
For they have dug a pit for my soul.
Remember how I stood before you to
speak good for them,
to turn away your wrath from them.
21 Therefore deliver up their children to
the famine,
and give them over to the power of
the sword.
Let their wives become childless and
widows.
Let their men be killed
and their young men struck by the
sword in battle.
22 Let a cry be heard from their houses
when you bring a troop suddenly on
them;
for they have dug a pit to take me
and hidden snares for my feet.
23 Yet, Yahweh, you know all their counsel
against me to kill me.
Don't forgive their iniquity.
Don't blot out their sin from your
sight,
Let them be overthrown before you.
Deal with them in the time of your
anger.

19

1 Thus said Yahweh, "Go, and buy a
potter's earthen container, and take some
of the elders of the people and of the
elders of the priests;
2 and go out to the valley of the son of
Hinnom, which is by the entry of the gate

Harsith, and proclaim there the words
that I will tell you.
3 Say, 'Hear Yahweh's word, kings of
Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem:
Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says,
"Behold, I will bring evil on this place,
which whoever hears, his ears will tingle.
4 Because they have forsaken me, and
have defiled this place, and have burned
incense in it to other gods that they didn't
know—they, their fathers, and the kings of
Judah—and have filled this place with the
blood of innocents,
5 and have built the high places of Baal
to burn their children in the fire for burnt
offerings to Baal, which I didn't
command, nor speak, which didn't even
enter into my mind.
6 Therefore, behold, the days come,"
says Yahweh, "that this place will no more
be called 'Topheth', nor 'The Valley of the
son of Hinnom', but 'The valley of
Slaughter'.
7 " ' "I will make the counsel of Judah
and Jerusalem void in this place. I will
cause them to fall by the sword before
their enemies, and by the hand of those
who seek their life. I will give their dead
bodies to be food for the birds of the sky
and for the animals of the earth.
8 I will make this city an astonishment
and a hissing. Everyone who passes by it
will be astonished and hiss because of all
its plagues.
9 I will cause them to eat the flesh of
their sons and the flesh of their daughters.
They will each eat the flesh of his friend in
the siege and in the distress with which
their enemies, and those who seek their
life, will distress them." '
10 "Then you shall break the container
in the sight of the men who go with you,
11 and shall tell them, 'Yahweh of
Armies says: "Even so I will break this
people and this city as one breaks a
potter's vessel, that can't be made whole
again. They will bury in Topheth until
there is no place to bury.
12 This is what I will do to this place,"
says Yahweh, "and to its inhabitants, even
making this city as Topheth.
13 The houses of Jerusalem and the
houses of the kings of Judah, which are
defiled, will be as the place of Topheth,
even all the houses on whose roofs they
have burned incense to all the army of the
sky and have poured out drink offerings
to other gods." ' "
14 Then Jeremiah came from Topheth,
where Yahweh had sent him to prophesy,
and he stood in the court of Yahweh's
house, and said to all the people:
15 "Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel
says, 'Behold, I will bring on this city and
on all its towns all the evil that I have
pronounced against it, because they have
made their neck stiff, that they may not
hear my words.' "

20

1 Now Pashhur, the son of Immer the
priest, who was chief officer in Yahweh's
house, heard Jeremiah prophesying these
things.
2 Then Pashhur struck Jeremiah the
prophet and put him in the stocks that
were in the upper gate of Benjamin,
which was in Yahweh's house.
3 On the next day, Pashhur released
Jeremiah out of the stocks. Then Jeremiah
said to him, "Yahweh has not called your
name Pashhur, but Magormissabib.†
4 For Yahweh says, 'Behold, I will make
you a terror to yourself and to all your
friends. They will fall by the sword of
their enemies, and your eyes will see it. I
will give all Judah into the hand of the
king of Babylon, and he will carry them
captive to Babylon, and will kill them with
the sword.
5 Moreover I will give all the riches of
this city, and all its gains, and all its
precious things, yes, I will give all the
treasures of the kings of Judah into the
hand of their enemies. They will make
them captives, take them, and carry them
to Babylon.
6 You, Pashhur, and all who dwell in
your house will go into captivity. You will
come to Babylon, and there you will die,

† **20:3** "Magormissabib" means "surrounded by terror"

and there you will be buried, you, and all your friends, to whom you have prophesied falsely.' "

7 Yahweh, you have persuaded me, and I was persuaded.
You are stronger than I, and have prevailed.
I have become a laughingstock all day.
Everyone mocks me.
8 For as often as I speak, I cry out;
I cry, "Violence and destruction!"
because Yahweh's word has been made a reproach to me,
and a derision, all day.
9 If I say that I will not make mention of him,
or speak any more in his name,
then there is in my heart as it were a burning fire shut up in my bones.
I am weary with holding it in.
I can't.
10 For I have heard the defaming of many:
"Terror on every side!
Denounce, and we will denounce him!"
say all my familiar friends,
those who watch for my fall.
"Perhaps he will be persuaded,
and we will prevail against him,
and we will take our revenge on him."
11 But Yahweh is with me as an awesome mighty one.
Therefore my persecutors will stumble,
and they won't prevail.
They will be utterly disappointed
because they have not dealt wisely,
even with an everlasting dishonor which will never be forgotten.
12 But Yahweh of Armies, who tests the righteous,
who sees the heart and the mind,
let me see your vengeance on them,
for I have revealed my cause to you.
13 Sing to Yahweh!
Praise Yahweh,
for he has delivered the soul of the needy from the hand of evildoers.
14 Cursed is the day in which I was born.
Don't let the day in which my mother bore me be blessed.
15 Cursed is the man who brought news to my father, saying,
"A boy is born to you," making him very glad.
16 Let that man be as the cities which Yahweh overthrew,
and didn't repent.
Let him hear a cry in the morning,
and shouting at noontime,
17 because he didn't kill me from the womb.
So my mother would have been my grave,
and her womb always great.
18 Why did I come out of the womb to see labor and sorrow,
that my days should be consumed with shame?

21

1 The word which came to Jeremiah from Yahweh, when King Zedekiah sent to him Pashhur the son of Malchijah, and Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah, the priest, saying,
2 "Please inquire of Yahweh for us; for Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon makes war against us. Perhaps Yahweh will deal with us according to all his wondrous works, that he may withdraw from us."
3 Then Jeremiah said to them, "Tell Zedekiah:
4 'Yahweh, the God of Israel says, "Behold, I will turn back the weapons of war that are in your hands, with which you fight against the king of Babylon, and against the Chaldeans who besiege you outside the walls; and I will gather them into the middle of this city.
5 I myself will fight against you with an outstretched hand and with a strong arm, even in anger, in wrath, and in great indignation.
6 I will strike the inhabitants of this city, both man and animal. They will die of a great pestilence.
7 Afterward," says Yahweh, "I will deliver Zedekiah king of Judah, his servants, and the people, even those who are left in this city from the pestilence, from the sword, and from the famine, into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of

Babylon, and into the hand of their
enemies, and into the hand of those who
seek their life. He will strike them with
the edge of the sword. He will not spare
them, have pity, or have mercy." '
8 "You shall say to this people, 'Yahweh
says: "Behold, I set before you the way of
life and the way of death.
9 He who remains in this city will die by
the sword, by the famine, and by the
pestilence, but he who goes out and passes
over to the Chaldeans who besiege you, he
will live, and he will escape with his life.
10 For I have set my face on this city for
evil, and not for good," says Yahweh. "It
will be given into the hand of the king of
Babylon, and he will burn it with fire." '
11 "Concerning the house of the king of
Judah, hear Yahweh's word:
12 House of David, Yahweh says,
'Execute justice in the morning,
and deliver him who is robbed out of
the hand of the oppressor,
lest my wrath go out like fire,
and burn so that no one can quench it,
because of the evil of your doings.
13 Behold, I am against you, O inhabitant
of the valley,
and of the rock of the plain,' says
Yahweh.
'You that say, "Who would come down
against us?"
or, "Who would enter into our
homes?"
14 I will punish you according to the fruit
of your doings,' says Yahweh;
'and I will kindle a fire in her forest,
and it will devour all that is around
her.' "

22

1 Yahweh said, "Go down to the house of
the king of Judah, and speak this word
there:
2 'Hear Yahweh's word, king of Judah,
who sits on David's throne—you, your
servants, and your people who enter in by
these gates.
3 Yahweh says: "Execute justice and
righteousness, and deliver him who is
robbed out of the hand of the oppressor.
Do no wrong. Do no violence to the
foreigner, the fatherless, or the widow.
Don't shed innocent blood in this place.
4 For if you do this thing indeed, then
kings sitting on David's throne will enter
in by the gates of this house, riding in
chariots and on horses—they, their
servants, and their people.
5 But if you will not hear these words, I
swear by myself," says Yahweh, "that this
house will become a desolation." ' "
6 For Yahweh says concerning the house
of the king of Judah:
"You are Gilead to me,
the head of Lebanon.
Yet surely I will make you a wilderness,
cities which are not inhabited.
7 I will prepare destroyers against you,
everyone with his weapons,
and they will cut down your choice
cedars,
and cast them into the fire.
8 "Many nations will pass by this city,
and they will each ask his neighbor, 'Why
has Yahweh done this to this great city?'
9 Then they will answer, 'Because they
abandoned the covenant of Yahweh their
God, worshiped other gods, and served
them.' "
10 Don't weep for the dead.
Don't bemoan him;
but weep bitterly for him who goes away,
for he will return no more,
and not see his native country.
11 For Yahweh says touching Shallum the
son of Josiah, king of Judah, who reigned
instead of Josiah his father, and who went
out of this place: "He won't return there
any more.
12 But he will die in the place where they
have led him captive. He will see this land
no more."
13 "Woe to him who builds his house by
unrighteousness,
and his rooms by injustice;
who uses his neighbor's service without
wages,
and doesn't give him his hire;
14 who says, 'I will build myself a wide
house and spacious rooms,'
and cuts out windows for himself,
with a cedar ceiling,
and painted with red.

15 “Should you reign because you strive to excel in cedar?
Didn’t your father eat and drink,
and do justice and righteousness?
Then it was well with him.
16 He judged the cause of the poor and needy;
so then it was well.
Wasn’t this to know me?”
says Yahweh.
17 But your eyes and your heart are only for your covetousness,
for shedding innocent blood,
for oppression, and for doing violence.”
18 Therefore Yahweh says concerning Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah:
“They won’t lament for him,
saying, ‘Ah my brother!’ or, ‘Ah sister!’
They won’t lament for him,
saying ‘Ah lord!’ or, ‘Ah his glory!’
19 He will be buried with the burial of a donkey,
drawn and cast out beyond the gates of Jerusalem.”

20 “Go up to Lebanon, and cry out.
Lift up your voice in Bashan,
and cry from Abarim;
for all your lovers have been destroyed.
21 I spoke to you in your prosperity,
but you said, ‘I will not listen.’
This has been your way from your youth,
that you didn’t obey my voice.
22 The wind will feed all your shepherds,
and your lovers will go into captivity.
Surely then you will be ashamed
and confounded for all your wickedness.
23 Inhabitant of Lebanon,
who makes your nest in the cedars,
how greatly to be pitied you will be when pangs come on you,
the pain as of a woman in travail!
24 “As I live,” says Yahweh, “though Coniah the son of Jehoiakim king of Judah were the signet on my right hand, I would still pluck you from there.
25 I would give you into the hand of those who seek your life, and into the hand of them of whom you are afraid, even into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and into the hand of the Chaldeans.
26 I will cast you out with your mother who bore you into another country, where you were not born; and there you will die.
27 But to the land to which their soul longs to return, there they will not return.”
28 Is this man Coniah a despised broken vessel?
Is he a vessel in which no one delights?
Why are they cast out, he and his offspring,
and cast into a land which they don’t know?
29 O earth, earth, earth,
hear Yahweh’s word!
30 Yahweh says,
“Record this man as childless,
a man who will not prosper in his days;
for no more will a man of his offspring prosper,
sitting on David’s throne
and ruling in Judah.”

23

1 “Woe to the shepherds who destroy and scatter the sheep of my pasture!” says Yahweh.
2 Therefore Yahweh, the God of Israel, says against the shepherds who feed my people: “You have scattered my flock, driven them away, and have not visited them. Behold, I will visit on you the evil of your doings,” says Yahweh.
3 “I will gather the remnant of my flock out of all the countries where I have driven them, and will bring them again to their folds; and they will be fruitful and multiply.
4 I will set up shepherds over them who will feed them. They will no longer be afraid or dismayed, neither will any be lacking,” says Yahweh.
5 “Behold, the days come,” says Yahweh,
“that I will raise to David a righteous Branch;
and he will reign as king and deal wisely,

and will execute justice and
righteousness in the land.
6 In his days Judah will be saved,
and Israel will dwell safely.
This is his name by which he will be
called:
Yahweh our righteousness.
7 “Therefore, behold, the days come,” says
Yahweh, “that they will no more say, ‘As
Yahweh lives, who brought up the
children of Israel out of the land of Egypt;’
8 but, ‘As Yahweh lives, who brought up
and who led the offspring of the house of
Israel out of the north country, and from
all the countries where I had driven
them.’ Then they will dwell in their own
land.”
9 Concerning the prophets:
My heart within me is broken.
All my bones shake.
I am like a drunken man,
and like a man whom wine has
overcome,
because of Yahweh,
and because of his holy words.
10 “For the land is full of adulterers;
for because of the curse the land
mourns.
The pastures of the wilderness have dried
up.
Their course is evil,
and their might is not right;
11 for both prophet and priest are profane.
Yes, in my house I have found their
wickedness,” says Yahweh.
12 Therefore their way will be to them as
slippery places in the darkness.
They will be driven on,
and fall therein;
for I will bring evil on them,
even the year of their visitation,” says
Yahweh.

13 “I have seen folly in the prophets of
Samaria.
They prophesied by Baal,
and caused my people Israel to err.
14 In the prophets of Jerusalem I have also
seen a horrible thing:
they commit adultery and walk in
lies.
They strengthen the hands of evildoers,
so that no one returns from his
wickedness.
They have all become to me as Sodom,
and its inhabitants as Gomorrah.”
15 Therefore Yahweh of Armies says
concerning the prophets:
“Behold, I will feed them with wormwood,
and make them drink poisoned
water;
for from the prophets of Jerusalem
ungodliness has gone out into all
the land.”
16 Yahweh of Armies says,
“Don’t listen to the words of the prophets
who prophesy to you.
They teach you vanity.
They speak a vision of their own
heart,
and not out of the mouth of Yahweh.
17 They say continually to those who
despise me,
‘Yahweh has said, “You will have
peace;” ’
and to everyone who walks in the
stubbornness of his own heart they
say,
‘No evil will come on you.’
18 For who has stood in the council of
Yahweh,
that he should perceive and hear his
word?
Who has listened to my word, and
heard it?
19 Behold, Yahweh’s storm, his wrath, has
gone out.
Yes, a whirling storm!
It will burst on the head of the wicked.
20 Yahweh’s anger will not return until he
has executed
and performed the intents of his
heart.
In the latter days, you will
understand it perfectly.
21 I didn’t send these prophets, yet they
ran.
I didn’t speak to them, yet they
prophesied.
22 But if they had stood in my council,
then they would have caused my
people to hear my words,
and would have turned them from their
evil way,
and from the evil of their doings.

23 “Am I a God at hand,” says Yahweh,
“and not a God afar off?
24 Can anyone hide himself in secret
places
so that I can’t see him?” says Yahweh.
“Don’t I fill heaven and earth?” says
Yahweh.
25 “I have heard what the prophets have
said, who prophesy lies in my name,
saying, ‘I had a dream! I had a dream!’
26 How long will this be in the heart of
the prophets who prophesy lies, even the
prophets of the deceit of their own heart?
27 They intend to cause my people to
forget my name by their dreams which
they each tell his neighbor, as their
fathers forgot my name because of Baal.
28 The prophet who has a dream, let him
tell a dream; and he who has my word, let
him speak my word faithfully. What is the
straw to the wheat?” says Yahweh.
29 “Isn’t my word like fire?” says
Yahweh; “and like a hammer that breaks
the rock in pieces?
30 “Therefore behold, I am against the
prophets,” says Yahweh, “who each steal
my words from his neighbor.
31 Behold, I am against the prophets,”
says Yahweh, “who use their tongues, and
say, ‘He says.’
32 Behold, I am against those who
prophesy lying dreams,” says Yahweh,
“who tell them, and cause my people to
err by their lies, and by their vain
boasting; yet I didn’t send them or
command them. They don’t profit this
people at all,” says Yahweh.
33 “When this people, or the prophet, or
a priest, asks you, saying, ‘What is the
message from Yahweh?’ Then you shall
tell them, ‘ “What message? I will cast you
off,” says Yahweh.’
34 As for the prophet, the priest, and the
people, who say, ‘The message from
Yahweh,’ I will even punish that man and
his household.
35 You will say everyone to his neighbor,
and everyone to his brother, ‘What has
Yahweh answered?’ and, ‘What has
Yahweh said?’
36 You will mention the message from
Yahweh no more, for every man’s own
word has become his message; for you
have perverted the words of the living
God, of Yahweh of Armies, our God.
37 You will say to the prophet, ‘What has
Yahweh answered you?’ and, ‘What has
Yahweh spoken?’
38 Although you say, ‘The message from
Yahweh,’ therefore Yahweh says: ‘Because
you say this word, “The message from
Yahweh,” and I have sent to you, telling
you not to say, “The message from
Yahweh,”
39 therefore behold, I will utterly forget
you, and I will cast you off with the city
that I gave to you and to your fathers,
away from my presence.
40 I will bring an everlasting reproach
on you, and a perpetual shame, which will
not be forgotten.’ ”

24

1 Yahweh showed me, and behold, two
baskets of figs were set before Yahweh’s
temple, after Nebuchadnezzar king of
Babylon had carried away captive
Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim, king of
Judah, and the princes of Judah, with the
craftsmen and smiths, from Jerusalem,
and had brought them to Babylon.
2 One basket had very good figs, like the
figs that are first-ripe; and the other
basket had very bad figs, which could not
be eaten, they were so bad.
3 Then Yahweh asked me, “What do you
see, Jeremiah?”
I said, “Figs. The good figs are very
good, and the bad are very bad, so bad
that they can’t be eaten.”
4 Yahweh’s word came to me, saying,
5 “Yahweh, the God of Israel says: ‘Like
these good figs, so I will regard the
captives of Judah, whom I have sent out of
this place into the land of the Chaldeans,
as good.
6 For I will set my eyes on them for good,
and I will bring them again to this land. I
will build them, and not pull them down. I
will plant them, and not pluck them up.

7 I will give them a heart to know me,
that I am Yahweh. They will be my people,
and I will be their God; for they will
return to me with their whole heart.
8 " 'As the bad figs, which can't be eaten,
they are so bad,' surely Yahweh says, 'So I
will give up Zedekiah the king of Judah,
and his princes, and the remnant of
Jerusalem who remain in this land, and
those who dwell in the land of Egypt.
9 I will even give them up to be tossed
back and forth among all the kingdoms of
the earth for evil, to be a reproach and a
proverb, a taunt and a curse, in all places
where I will drive them.
10 I will send the sword, the famine, and
the pestilence among them, until they are
consumed from off the land that I gave to
them and to their fathers.' "

25

1 The word that came to Jeremiah
concerning all the people of Judah, in the
fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah,
king of Judah (this was the first year of
Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon),
2 which Jeremiah the prophet spoke to
all the people of Judah, and to all the
inhabitants of Jerusalem:
3 From the thirteenth year of Josiah the
son of Amon, king of Judah, even to this
day, these twenty-three years, Yahweh's
word has come to me, and I have spoken
to you, rising up early and speaking; but
you have not listened.
4 Yahweh has sent to you all his servants
the prophets, rising up early and sending
them (but you have not listened or
inclined your ear to hear),
5 saying, "Return now everyone from
his evil way, and from the evil of your
doings, and dwell in the land that Yahweh
has given to you and to your fathers, from
of old and even forever more.
6 Don't go after other gods to serve them
or worship them, and don't provoke me to
anger with the work of your hands; then I
will do you no harm."
7 "Yet you have not listened to me," says
Yahweh, "that you may provoke me to
anger with the work of your hands to
your own hurt."
8 Therefore Yahweh of Armies says:
"Because you have not heard my words,
9 behold, I will send and take all the
families of the north," says Yahweh, "and I
will send to Nebuchadnezzar the king of
Babylon, my servant, and will bring them
against this land, and against its
inhabitants, and against all these nations
around. I will utterly destroy them, and
make them an astonishment, and a
hissing, and perpetual desolations.
10 Moreover I will take from them the
voice of mirth and the voice of gladness,
the voice of the bridegroom and the voice
of the bride, the sound of the millstones,
and the light of the lamp.
11 This whole land will be a desolation,
and an astonishment; and these nations
will serve the king of Babylon seventy
years.
12 "It will happen, when seventy years
are accomplished, that I will punish the
king of Babylon and that nation," says
Yahweh, "for their iniquity. I will make
the land of the Chaldeans desolate
forever.
13 I will bring on that land all my words
which I have pronounced against it, even
all that is written in this book, which
Jeremiah has prophesied against all the
nations.
14 For many nations and great kings will
make bondservants of them, even of
them. I will recompense them according
to their deeds, and according to the work
of their hands."
15 For Yahweh, the God of Israel, says to
me: "Take this cup of the wine of wrath
from my hand, and cause all the nations
to whom I send you to drink it.
16 They will drink, and reel back and
forth, and be insane, because of the sword
that I will send among them."
17 Then I took the cup at Yahweh's hand,
and made all the nations to drink, to
whom Yahweh had sent me:
18 Jerusalem, and the cities of Judah,
with its kings and its princes, to make
them a desolation, an astonishment, a
hissing, and a curse, as it is today;

19 Pharaoh king of Egypt, with his
servants, his princes, and all his people;
20 and all the mixed people, and all the
kings of the land of Uz, all the kings of the
Philistines, Ashkelon, Gaza, Ekron, and
the remnant of Ashdod;
21 Edom, Moab, and the children of
Ammon;
22 and all the kings of Tyre, all the kings
of Sidon, and the kings of the isle which is
beyond the sea;
23 Dedan, Tema, Buz, and all who have
the corners of their beard cut off;
24 and all the kings of Arabia, all the
kings of the mixed people who dwell in
the wilderness;
25 and all the kings of Zimri, all the kings
of Elam, and all the kings of the Medes;
26 and all the kings of the north, far and
near, one with another; and all the
kingdoms of the world, which are on the
surface of the earth. The king of Sheshach
will drink after them.
27 "You shall tell them, 'Yahweh of
Armies, the God of Israel says: "Drink, and
be drunk, vomit, fall, and rise no more,
because of the sword which I will send
among you." '
28 It shall be, if they refuse to take the
cup at your hand to drink, then you shall
tell them, 'Yahweh of Armies says: "You
shall surely drink.
29 For, behold, I begin to work evil at the
city which is called by my name; and
should you be utterly unpunished? You
will not be unpunished; for I will call for a
sword on all the inhabitants of the earth,
says Yahweh of Armies." '
30 "Therefore prophesy against them all
these words, and tell them,
" 'Yahweh will roar from on high,
and utter his voice from his holy
habitation.
He will mightily roar against his fold.
He will give a shout, as those who tread
grapes,
against all the inhabitants of the
earth.
31 A noise will come even to the end of the
earth;
for Yahweh has a controversy with
the nations.
He will enter into judgment with all flesh.
As for the wicked, he will give them to
the sword," ' says Yahweh."
32 Yahweh of Armies says,
"Behold, evil will go out from nation to
nation,
and a great storm will be raised up
from the uttermost parts of the
earth."
33 The slain of Yahweh will be at that day
from one end of the earth even to the
other end of the earth. They won't be
lamented. They won't be gathered or
buried. They will be dung on the surface
of the ground.
34 Wail, you shepherds, and cry.
Wallow in dust, you leader of the
flock;
for the days of your slaughter and of your
dispersions have fully come,
and you will fall like fine pottery.
35 The shepherds will have no way to flee.
The leader of the flock will have no
escape.
36 A voice of the cry of the shepherds,
and the wailing of the leader of the
flock,
for Yahweh destroys their pasture.
37 The peaceful folds are brought to
silence
because of the fierce anger of
Yahweh.
38 He has left his covert, as the lion;
for their land has become an
astonishment because of the
fierceness of the oppression,
and because of his fierce anger.

26

1 In the beginning of the reign of
Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah,
this word came from Yahweh:
2 "Yahweh says: 'Stand in the court of
Yahweh's house, and speak to all the cities
of Judah which come to worship in
Yahweh's house, all the words that I
command you to speak to them. Don't
omit a word.
3 It may be they will listen, and every
man turn from his evil way, that I may
relent from the evil which I intend to do to
them because of the evil of their doings.' "

4 You shall tell them, “Yahweh says: ‘If
you will not listen to me, to walk in my
law which I have set before you,
5 to listen to the words of my servants
the prophets whom I send to you, even
rising up early and sending them—but you
have not listened—
6 then I will make this house like Shiloh,
and will make this city a curse to all the
nations of the earth.’ ”
7 The priests and the prophets and all
the people heard Jeremiah speaking these
words in Yahweh’s house.
8 When Jeremiah had finished speaking
all that Yahweh had commanded him to
speak to all the people, the priests and the
prophets and all the people seized him,
saying, “You shall surely die!
9 Why have you prophesied in Yahweh’s
name, saying, ‘This house will be like
Shiloh, and this city will be desolate,
without inhabitant’?” All the people were
crowded around Jeremiah in Yahweh’s
house.
10 When the princes of Judah heard
these things, they came up from the king’s
house to Yahweh’s house; and they sat in
the entry of the new gate of Yahweh’s
house.
11 Then the priests and the prophets
spoke to the princes and to all the people,
saying, “This man is worthy of death, for
he has prophesied against this city, as you
have heard with your ears.”
12 Then Jeremiah spoke to all the
princes and to all the people, saying,
“Yahweh sent me to prophesy against this
house and against this city all the words
that you have heard.
13 Now therefore amend your ways and
your doings, and obey Yahweh your God’s
voice; then Yahweh will relent from the
evil that he has pronounced against you.
14 But as for me, behold, I am in your
hand. Do with me what is good and right
in your eyes.
15 Only know for certain that if you put
me to death, you will bring innocent
blood on yourselves, on this city, and on
its inhabitants; for in truth Yahweh has
sent me to you to speak all these words in
your ears.”
16 Then the princes and all the people
said to the priests and to the prophets:
“This man is not worthy of death; for he
has spoken to us in the name of Yahweh
our God.”
17 Then certain of the elders of the land
rose up, and spoke to all the assembly of
the people, saying,
18 “Micah the Morashtite prophesied in
the days of Hezekiah king of Judah; and
he spoke to all the people of Judah, saying,
‘Yahweh of Armies says:
“ ‘Zion will be plowed as a field,
and Jerusalem will become heaps,
and the mountain of the house as the
high places of a forest.’
19 Did Hezekiah king of Judah and all
Judah put him to death? Didn’t he fear
Yahweh, and entreat the favor of Yahweh,
and Yahweh relented of the disaster
which he had pronounced against them?
We would commit great evil against our
own souls that way!”
20 There was also a man who
prophesied in Yahweh’s name, Uriah the
son of Shemaiah of Kiriath Jearim; and he
prophesied against this city and against
this land according to all the words of
Jeremiah.
21 When Jehoiakim the king, with all his
mighty men and all the princes heard his
words, the king sought to put him to
death; but when Uriah heard it, he was
afraid, and fled, and went into Egypt.
22 Then Jehoiakim the king sent
Elnathan the son of Achbor and certain
men with him into Egypt.
23 They fetched Uriah out of Egypt and
brought him to Jehoiakim the king, who
killed him with the sword and cast his
dead body into the graves of the common
people.
24 But the hand of Ahikam the son of
Shaphan was with Jeremiah, so that they
didn’t give him into the hand of the people
to put him to death.

27

1 In the beginning of the reign of
Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah,
this word came to Jeremiah from Yahweh,
saying,

2 Yahweh says to me: “Make bonds and
bars, and put them on your neck.
3 Then send them to the king of Edom, to
the king of Moab, to the king of the
children of Ammon, to the king of Tyre,
and to the king of Sidon, by the hand of
the messengers who come to Jerusalem to
Zedekiah king of Judah.
4 Give them a command to their
masters, saying, ‘Yahweh of Armies, the
God of Israel says, “You shall tell your
masters:
5 ‘I have made the earth, the men, and
the animals that are on the surface of the
earth by my great power and by my
outstretched arm. I give it to whom it
seems right to me.
6 Now I have given all these lands into
the hand of Nebuchadnezzar the king of
Babylon, my servant. I have also given the
animals of the field to him to serve him.
7 All the nations will serve him, his son,
and his son’s son, until the time of his own
land comes. Then many nations and great
kings will make him their bondservant.
8 “ ‘ “ ‘It will happen that I will punish
the nation and the kingdom which will
not serve the same Nebuchadnezzar king
of Babylon, and that will not put their
neck under the yoke of the king of
Babylon,’ says Yahweh, ‘with the sword,
with famine, and with pestilence, until I
have consumed them by his hand.
9 But as for you, don’t listen to your
prophets, to your diviners, to your
dreams, to your soothsayers, or to your
sorcerers, who speak to you, saying, “You
shall not serve the king of Babylon;”
10 for they prophesy a lie to you, to
remove you far from your land, so that I
would drive you out, and you would
perish.
11 But the nation that brings their neck
under the yoke of the king of Babylon and
serves him, that nation I will let remain in
their own land,’ says Yahweh; ‘and they
will till it and dwell in it.’ ” ’ ”
12 I spoke to Zedekiah king of Judah
according to all these words, saying,
“Bring your necks under the yoke of the
king of Babylon, and serve him and his
people, and live.
13 Why will you die, you and your
people, by the sword, by the famine, and
by the pestilence, as Yahweh has spoken
concerning the nation that will not serve
the king of Babylon?
14 Don’t listen to the words of the
prophets who speak to you, saying, ‘You
shall not serve the king of Babylon;’ for
they prophesy a lie to you.
15 For I have not sent them,” says
Yahweh, “but they prophesy falsely in my
name; that I may drive you out, and that
you may perish, you, and the prophets
who prophesy to you.”

16 Also I spoke to the priests and to all
this people, saying, Yahweh says, “Don’t
listen to the words of your prophets who
prophesy to you, saying, ‘Behold, the
vessels of Yahweh’s house will now
shortly be brought again from Babylon;’
for they prophesy a lie to you.
17 Don’t listen to them. Serve the king of
Babylon, and live. Why should this city
become a desolation?
18 But if they are prophets, and if
Yahweh’s word is with them, let them now
make intercession to Yahweh of Armies,
that the vessels which are left in Yahweh’s
house, in the house of the king of Judah,
and at Jerusalem, don’t go to Babylon.
19 For Yahweh of Armies says
concerning the pillars, concerning the sea,
concerning the bases, and concerning the
rest of the vessels that are left in this city,
20 which Nebuchadnezzar king of
Babylon didn’t take when he carried away
captive Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim,
king of Judah, from Jerusalem to Babylon,
and all the nobles of Judah and
Jerusalem—
21 yes, Yahweh of Armies, the God of
Israel, says concerning the vessels that are
left in Yahweh’s house, and in the house of
the king of Judah, and at Jerusalem:
22 ‘They will be carried to Babylon, and
there they will be, until the day that I visit
them,’ says Yahweh; ‘then I will bring
them up, and restore them to this place.’ ”

28

1 That same year, in the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, in the fourth year, in the fifth month, Hananiah the son of Azzur, the prophet, who was of Gibeon, spoke to me in Yahweh's house, in the presence of the priests and of all the people, saying,
2 "Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says, 'I have broken the yoke of the king of Babylon.
3 Within two full years I will bring again into this place all the vessels of Yahweh's house that Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon took away from this place and carried to Babylon.
4 I will bring again to this place Jeconiah the son of Jehoiakim, king of Judah, with all the captives of Judah, who went to Babylon,' says Yahweh; 'for I will break the yoke of the king of Babylon.' "
5 Then the prophet Jeremiah said to the prophet Hananiah in the presence of the priests, and in the presence of all the people who stood in Yahweh's house,
6 even the prophet Jeremiah said, "Amen! May Yahweh do so. May Yahweh perform your words which you have prophesied, to bring again the vessels of Yahweh's house, and all those who are captives, from Babylon to this place.
7 Nevertheless listen now to this word that I speak in your ears, and in the ears of all the people:
8 The prophets who have been before me and before you of old prophesied against many countries, and against great kingdoms, of war, of evil, and of pestilence.
9 As for the prophet who prophesies of peace, when the word of the prophet happens, then the prophet will be known, that Yahweh has truly sent him."
10 Then Hananiah the prophet took the bar from off the prophet Jeremiah's neck, and broke it.
11 Hananiah spoke in the presence of all the people, saying, "Yahweh says: 'Even so I will break the yoke of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon from off the neck of all the nations within two full years.' " Then the prophet Jeremiah went his way.
12 Then Yahweh's word came to Jeremiah, after Hananiah the prophet had broken the bar from off the neck of the prophet Jeremiah, saying,
13 "Go, and tell Hananiah, saying, 'Yahweh says, "You have broken the bars of wood, but you have made in their place bars of iron."
14 For Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says, "I have put a yoke of iron on the neck of all these nations, that they may serve Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon; and they will serve him. I have also given him the animals of the field." ' "
15 Then the prophet Jeremiah said to Hananiah the prophet, "Listen, Hananiah! Yahweh has not sent you, but you make this people trust in a lie.
16 Therefore Yahweh says, 'Behold, I will send you away from off the surface of the earth. This year you will die, because you have spoken rebellion against Yahweh.' "
17 So Hananiah the prophet died the same year in the seventh month.

29

1 Now these are the words of the letter that Jeremiah the prophet sent from Jerusalem to the residue of the elders of the captivity, and to the priests, to the prophets, and to all the people whom Nebuchadnezzar had carried away captive from Jerusalem to Babylon,
2 (after Jeconiah the king, the queen mother, the eunuchs, the princes of Judah and Jerusalem, the craftsmen, and the smiths had departed from Jerusalem),
3 by the hand of Elasah the son of Shaphan and Gemariah the son of Hilkiah, (whom Zedekiah king of Judah sent to Babylon to Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon). It said:
4 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says to all the captives whom I have caused to be carried away captive from Jerusalem to Babylon:
5 "Build houses and dwell in them. Plant gardens and eat their fruit.

6 Take wives and father sons and
daughters. Take wives for your sons, and
give your daughters to husbands, that
they may bear sons and daughters.
Multiply there, and don't be diminished.
7 Seek the peace of the city where I
have caused you to be carried away
captive, and pray to Yahweh for it; for in
its peace you will have peace."
8 For Yahweh of Armies, the God of
Israel says: "Don't let your prophets who
are among you and your diviners deceive
you. Don't listen to your dreams which
you cause to be dreamed.
9 For they prophesy falsely to you in
my name. I have not sent them," says
Yahweh.
10 For Yahweh says, "After seventy
years are accomplished for Babylon, I will
visit you and perform my good word
toward you, in causing you to return to
this place.
11 For I know the thoughts that I think
toward you," says Yahweh, "thoughts of
peace, and not of evil, to give you hope
and a future.
12 You shall call on me, and you shall
go and pray to me, and I will listen to you.
13 You shall seek me and find me,
when you search for me with all your
heart.
14 I will be found by you," says
Yahweh, "and I will turn again your
captivity, and I will gather you from all
the nations, and from all the places where
I have driven you," says Yahweh. "I will
bring you again to the place from where I
caused you to be carried away captive."
15 Because you have said, "Yahweh
has raised us up prophets in Babylon,"
16 Yahweh says concerning the king
who sits on David's throne, and
concerning all the people who dwell in
this city, your brothers who haven't gone
with you into captivity,
17 Yahweh of Armies says: "Behold, I
will send on them the sword, the famine,
and the pestilence, and will make them
like rotten figs that can't be eaten, they are
so bad.
18 I will pursue after them with the
sword, with the famine, and with the
pestilence, and will deliver them to be
tossed back and forth among all the
kingdoms of the earth, to be an object of
horror, an astonishment, a hissing, and a
reproach among all the nations where I
have driven them,
19 because they have not listened to
my words," says Yahweh, "with which I
sent to them my servants the prophets,
rising up early and sending them; but you
would not hear," says Yahweh.
20 Hear therefore Yahweh's word, all
you captives whom I have sent away
from Jerusalem to Babylon.
21 Yahweh of Armies, the God of
Israel, says concerning Ahab the son of
Kolaiah, and concerning Zedekiah the son
of Maaseiah, who prophesy a lie to you in
my name: "Behold, I will deliver them
into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of
Babylon; and he will kill them before your
eyes.
22 A curse will be taken up about them
by all the captives of Judah who are in
Babylon, saying, 'Yahweh make you like
Zedekiah and like Ahab, whom the king of
Babylon roasted in the fire;'
23 because they have done foolish
things in Israel, and have committed
adultery with their neighbors' wives, and
have spoken words in my name falsely,
which I didn't command them. I am he
who knows, and am witness," says
Yahweh.
24 Concerning Shemaiah the Nehelamite
you shall speak, saying,
25 "Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel,
says, 'Because you have sent letters in
your own name to all the people who are
at Jerusalem, and to Zephaniah the son of
Maaseiah, the priest, and to all the priests,
saying,
26 "Yahweh has made you priest in the
place of Jehoiada the priest, that there
may be officers in Yahweh's house, for
every man who is crazy and makes
himself a prophet, that you should put
him in the stocks and in shackles.
27 Now therefore, why have you not
rebuked Jeremiah of Anathoth, who

makes himself a prophet to you,
28 because he has sent to us in Babylon,
saying, The captivity is long. Build houses,
and dwell in them. Plant gardens, and eat
their fruit?" ' "
29 Zephaniah the priest read this letter
in the hearing of Jeremiah the prophet.
30 Then Yahweh's word came to
Jeremiah, saying,
31 "Send to all of the captives, saying,
'Yahweh says concerning Shemaiah the
Nehelamite: "Because Shemaiah has
prophesied to you, and I didn't send him,
and he has caused you to trust in a lie,"
32 therefore Yahweh says, "Behold, I will
punish Shemaiah the Nehelamite and his
offspring. He will not have a man to dwell
among this people. He won't see the good
that I will do to my people," says Yahweh,
"because he has spoken rebellion against
Yahweh." ' "

30

1 The word that came to Jeremiah from
Yahweh, saying,
2 "Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, 'Write
all the words that I have spoken to you in
a book.
3 For, behold, the days come,' says
Yahweh, 'that I will reverse the captivity
of my people Israel and Judah,' says
Yahweh. 'I will cause them to return to the
land that I gave to their fathers, and they
will possess it.' "

4 These are the words that Yahweh
spoke concerning Israel and concerning
Judah.
5 For Yahweh says:

"We have heard a voice of trembling;
a voice of fear, and not of peace.
6 Ask now, and see whether a man travails
with child.
Why do I see every man with his
hands on his waist, as a woman in
travail,
and all faces are turned pale?
7 Alas, for that day is great, so that none is
like it!
It is even the time of Jacob's trouble;
but he will be saved out of it.
8 It will come to pass in that day, says
Yahweh of Armies, that I will break
his yoke from off your neck,
and will burst your bonds.
Strangers will no more make them
their bondservants;
9 but they will serve Yahweh their God,
and David their king,
whom I will raise up to them.
10 Therefore don't be afraid, O Jacob my
servant, says Yahweh.
Don't be dismayed, Israel.
For, behold, I will save you from afar,
and save your offspring from the land
of their captivity.
Jacob will return,
and will be quiet and at ease.
No one will make him afraid.
11 For I am with you, says Yahweh, to save
you;
for I will make a full end of all the
nations where I have scattered you,
but I will not make a full end of you;
but I will correct you in measure,
and will in no way leave you
unpunished."
12 For Yahweh says,
"Your hurt is incurable.
Your wound is grievous.
13 There is no one to plead your cause,
that you may be bound up.
You have no healing medicines.
14 All your lovers have forgotten you.
They don't seek you.
For I have wounded you with the wound
of an enemy,
with the chastisement of a cruel one,
for the greatness of your iniquity,
because your sins were increased.
15 Why do you cry over your injury?
Your pain is incurable.
For the greatness of your iniquity,
because your sins have increased,
I have done these things to you.
16 Therefore all those who devour you will
be devoured.
All your adversaries, everyone of
them, will go into captivity.
Those who plunder you will be plunder.
I will make all who prey on you
become prey.

17 For I will restore health to you,
and I will heal you of your wounds,"
says Yahweh,
"because they have called you an outcast,
saying, 'It is Zion, whom no man seeks
after.' "
18 Yahweh says:
"Behold, I will reverse the captivity of
Jacob's tents,
and have compassion on his dwelling
places.
The city will be built on its own hill,
and the palace will be inhabited in its
own place.
19 Thanksgiving will proceed out of them
with the voice of those who make
merry.
I will multiply them,
and they will not be few;
I will also glorify them,
and they will not be small.
20 Their children also will be as before,
and their congregation will be
established before me.
I will punish all who oppress them.
21 Their prince will be one of them,
and their ruler will proceed from
among them.
I will cause him to draw near,
and he will approach me;
for who is he who has had boldness to
approach me?" says Yahweh.
22 "You shall be my people,
and I will be your God.
23 Behold, Yahweh's storm, his wrath, has
gone out,
a sweeping storm;
it will burst on the head of the wicked.
24 The fierce anger of Yahweh will not
return until he has accomplished,
and until he has performed the
intentions of his heart.
In the latter days you will understand
it."

31

1 "At that time," says Yahweh, "I will be
the God of all the families of Israel, and
they will be my people."
2 Yahweh says, "The people who survive
the sword found favor in the wilderness;
even Israel, when I went to cause him to
rest."
3 Yahweh appeared of old to me, saying,
"Yes, I have loved you with an everlasting
love.
Therefore I have drawn you with
loving kindness.
4 I will build you again,
and you will be built, O virgin of
Israel.
You will again be adorned with your
tambourines,
and will go out in the dances of those
who make merry.
5 Again you will plant vineyards on the
mountains of Samaria.
The planters will plant,
and will enjoy its fruit.
6 For there will be a day that the
watchmen on the hills of Ephraim
cry,
'Arise! Let's go up to Zion to Yahweh
our God.' "
7 For Yahweh says,
"Sing with gladness for Jacob,
and shout for the chief of the nations.
Publish, praise, and say,
'Yahweh, save your people,
the remnant of Israel!'
8 Behold, I will bring them from the north
country,
and gather them from the uttermost
parts of the earth,
along with the blind and the lame,
the woman with child and her who
travails with child together.
They will return as a great company.
9 They will come with weeping.
I will lead them with petitions.
I will cause them to walk by rivers of
waters,
in a straight way in which they won't
stumble;
for I am a father to Israel.
Ephraim is my firstborn.

10 "Hear Yahweh's word, you nations,
and declare it in the distant islands.
Say,
'He who scattered Israel will gather him,
and keep him, as a shepherd does his
flock.'
11 For Yahweh has ransomed Jacob,

and redeemed him from the hand of
him who was stronger than he.
12 They will come and sing in the height of
Zion,
and will flow to the goodness of
Yahweh,
to the grain, to the new wine, to the oil,
and to the young of the flock and of
the herd.
Their soul will be as a watered garden.
They will not sorrow any more at all.
13 Then the virgin will rejoice in the dance,
the young men and the old together;
for I will turn their mourning into joy,
and will comfort them, and make
them rejoice from their sorrow.
14 I will satiate the soul of the priests with
fatness,
and my people will be satisfied with
my goodness," says Yahweh.

15 Yahweh says:
"A voice is heard in Ramah,
lamentation and bitter weeping,
Rachel weeping for her children.
She refuses to be comforted for her
children,
because they are no more."
16 Yahweh says:
"Refrain your voice from weeping,
and your eyes from tears,
for your work will be rewarded," says
Yahweh.
"They will come again from the land
of the enemy.
17 There is hope for your latter end," says
Yahweh.
"Your children will come again to
their own territory.

18 "I have surely heard Ephraim grieving
thus,
'You have chastised me,
and I was chastised, as an untrained
calf.
Turn me, and I will be turned,
for you are Yahweh my God.
19 Surely after that I was turned.
I repented.
After that I was instructed.
I struck my thigh.
I was ashamed, yes, even confounded,
because I bore the reproach of my
youth.'
20 Is Ephraim my dear son?
Is he a darling child?
For as often as I speak against him,
I still earnestly remember him.
Therefore my heart yearns for him.
I will surely have mercy on him," says
Yahweh.

21 "Set up road signs.
Make guideposts.
Set your heart toward the highway,
even the way by which you went.
Turn again, virgin of Israel.
Turn again to these your cities.
22 How long will you go here and there,
you backsliding daughter?
For Yahweh has created a new thing in the
earth:
a woman will encompass a man."

23 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel,
says: "Yet again they will use this speech
in the land of Judah and in its cities, when
I reverse their captivity: 'Yahweh bless
you, habitation of righteousness,
mountain of holiness.'
24 Judah and all its cities will dwell
therein together, the farmers, and those
who go about with flocks.
25 For I have satiated the weary soul,
and I have replenished every sorrowful
soul."
26 On this I awakened, and saw; and my
sleep was sweet to me.
27 "Behold, the days come," says
Yahweh, "that I will sow the house of
Israel and the house of Judah with the
seed of man and with the seed of animal.
28 It will happen that, like as I have
watched over them to pluck up and to
break down and to overthrow and to
destroy and to afflict, so I will watch over
them to build and to plant," says Yahweh.
29 "In those days they will say no more,
" 'The fathers have eaten sour grapes,
and the children's teeth are set on
edge.'
30 But everyone will die for his own
iniquity. Every man who eats the sour
grapes, his teeth will be set on edge.

31 “Behold, the days come,” says
Yahweh, “that I will make a new covenant
with the house of Israel, and with the
house of Judah,
32 not according to the covenant that I
made with their fathers in the day that I
took them by the hand to bring them out
of the land of Egypt, which covenant of
mine they broke, although I was a
husband to them,” says Yahweh.
33 “But this is the covenant that I will
make with the house of Israel after those
days,” says Yahweh:
“I will put my law in their inward parts,
and I will write it in their heart.
I will be their God,
and they shall be my people.
34 They will no longer each teach his
neighbor,
and every man teach his brother,
saying, ‘Know Yahweh;’
for they will all know me,
from their least to their greatest,”
says Yahweh,
“for I will forgive their iniquity,
and I will remember their sin no
more.”
35 Yahweh, who gives the sun for a light by
day,
and the ordinances of the moon and
of the stars for a light by night,
who stirs up the sea, so that its waves
roar—
Yahweh of Armies is his name, says:
36 “If these ordinances depart from before
me,” says Yahweh,
“then the offspring of Israel also will
cease from being a nation before
me forever.”
37 Yahweh says: “If heaven above can be
measured,
and the foundations of the earth
searched out beneath,
then I will also cast off all the
offspring of Israel for all that they
have done,” says Yahweh.
38 “Behold, the days come,” says
Yahweh, “that the city will be built to
Yahweh from the tower of Hananel to the
gate of the corner.
39 The measuring line will go out
further straight onward to the hill Gareb,
and will turn toward Goah.
40 The whole valley of the dead bodies
and of the ashes, and all the fields to the
brook Kidron, to the corner of the horse
gate toward the east, will be holy to
Yahweh. It will not be plucked up or
thrown down any more forever.”

32

1 This is the word that came to Jeremiah
from Yahweh in the tenth year of
Zedekiah king of Judah, which was the
eighteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar.
2 Now at that time the king of Babylon’s
army was besieging Jerusalem. Jeremiah
the prophet was shut up in the court of
the guard, which was in the king of
Judah’s house.

3 For Zedekiah king of Judah had shut
him up, saying, “Why do you prophesy,
and say, ‘Yahweh says, “Behold, I will give
this city into the hand of the king of
Babylon, and he will take it;
4 and Zedekiah king of Judah won’t
escape out of the hand of the Chaldeans,
but will surely be delivered into the hand
of the king of Babylon, and will speak with
him mouth to mouth, and his eyes will see
his eyes;
5 and he will bring Zedekiah to Babylon,
and he will be there until I visit him,” says
Yahweh, “though you fight with the
Chaldeans, you will not prosper” ’?”

6 Jeremiah said, “Yahweh’s word came
to me, saying,
7 ‘Behold, Hanamel the son of Shallum
your uncle will come to you, saying, “Buy
my field that is in Anathoth; for the right
of redemption is yours to buy it.” ’ ”

8 “So Hanamel my uncle’s son came to
me in the court of the guard according to
Yahweh’s word, and said to me, ‘Please
buy my field that is in Anathoth, which is
in the land of Benjamin; for the right of
inheritance is yours, and the redemption
is yours. Buy it for yourself.’

“Then I knew that this was Yahweh’s
word.
9 I bought the field that was in Anathoth
of Hanamel my uncle’s son, and weighed

him the money, even seventeen shekels† of silver.
10 I signed the deed, sealed it, called witnesses, and weighed the money in the balances to him.
11 So I took the deed of the purchase, both that which was sealed, containing the terms and conditions, and that which was open;
12 and I delivered the deed of the purchase to Baruch the son of Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, in the presence of Hanamel my uncle's son, and in the presence of the witnesses who signed the deed of the purchase, before all the Jews who sat in the court of the guard.

13 "I commanded Baruch before them, saying,
14 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'Take these deeds, this deed of the purchase which is sealed, and this deed which is open, and put them in an earthen vessel, that they may last many days.'
15 For Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel says: 'Houses and fields and vineyards will yet again be bought in this land.'

16 Now after I had delivered the deed of the purchase to Baruch the son of Neriah, I prayed to Yahweh, saying,

17 "Ah Lord Yahweh! Behold, you have made the heavens and the earth by your great power and by your outstretched arm. There is nothing too hard for you.
18 You show loving kindness to thousands, and repay the iniquity of the fathers into the bosom of their children after them. The great, the mighty God, Yahweh of Armies is your name:
19 great in counsel, and mighty in work; whose eyes are open to all the ways of the children of men, to give everyone according to his ways, and according to the fruit of his doings;
20 who performed signs and wonders in the land of Egypt, even to this day, both in Israel and among other men; and made yourself a name, as it is today;
21 and brought your people Israel out of the land of Egypt with signs, with wonders, with a strong hand, with an outstretched arm, and with great terror;
22 and gave them this land, which you swore to their fathers to give them, a land flowing with milk and honey.
23 They came in and possessed it, but they didn't obey your voice and didn't walk in your law. They have done nothing of all that you commanded them to do. Therefore you have caused all this evil to come upon them.
24 "Behold, siege ramps have been built against the city to take it. The city is given into the hand of the Chaldeans who fight against it, because of the sword, of the famine, and of the pestilence. What you have spoken has happened. Behold, you see it.
25 You have said to me, Lord Yahweh, 'Buy the field for money, and call witnesses;' whereas the city is given into the hand of the Chaldeans."
26 Then Yahweh's word came to Jeremiah, saying,
27 "Behold, I am Yahweh, the God of all flesh. Is there anything too hard for me?
28 Therefore Yahweh says: Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the Chaldeans, and into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, and he will take it.
29 The Chaldeans, who fight against this city, will come and set this city on fire, and burn it with the houses on whose roofs they have offered incense to Baal, and poured out drink offerings to other gods, to provoke me to anger.
30 "For the children of Israel and the children of Judah have done only that which was evil in my sight from their youth; for the children of Israel have only provoked me to anger with the work of their hands, says Yahweh.
31 For this city has been to me a provocation of my anger and of my wrath from the day that they built it even to this day, so that I should remove it from before my face,

† **32:9** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

32 because of all the evil of the children
of Israel and of the children of Judah,
which they have done to provoke me to
anger—they, their kings, their princes,
their priests, their prophets, the men of
Judah, and the inhabitants of Jerusalem.
33 They have turned their backs to me,
and not their faces. Although I taught
them, rising up early and teaching them,
yet they have not listened to receive
instruction.
34 But they set their abominations in the
house which is called by my name, to
defile it.
35 They built the high places of Baal,
which are in the valley of the son of
Hinnom, to cause their sons and their
daughters to pass through fire to Molech,
which I didn't command them. It didn't
even come into my mind, that they should
do this abomination, to cause Judah to
sin."
36 Now therefore Yahweh, the God of
Israel, says concerning this city, about
which you say, "It is given into the hand of
the king of Babylon by the sword, by the
famine, and by the pestilence:"
37 "Behold, I will gather them out of all
the countries where I have driven them in
my anger, and in my wrath, and in great
indignation; and I will bring them again
to this place. I will cause them to dwell
safely.
38 Then they will be my people, and I
will be their God.
39 I will give them one heart and one
way, that they may fear me forever, for
their good and the good of their children
after them.
40 I will make an everlasting covenant
with them, that I will not turn away from
following them, to do them good. I will
put my fear in their hearts, that they may
not depart from me.
41 Yes, I will rejoice over them to do
them good, and I will plant them in this
land assuredly with my whole heart and
with my whole soul."
42 For Yahweh says: "Just as I have
brought all this great evil on this people,
so I will bring on them all the good that I
have promised them.
43 Fields will be bought in this land,
about which you say, 'It is desolate,
without man or animal. It is given into the
hand of the Chaldeans.'
44 Men will buy fields for money, sign
the deeds, seal them, and call witnesses,
in the land of Benjamin, and in the places
around Jerusalem, in the cities of Judah,
in the cities of the hill country, in the cities
of the lowland, and in the cities of the
South; for I will cause their captivity to be
reversed," says Yahweh.

33

1 Moreover Yahweh's word came to
Jeremiah the second time, while he was
still locked up in the court of the guard,
saying,
2 "Yahweh who does it, Yahweh who
forms it to establish it—Yahweh is his
name, says:
3 'Call to me, and I will answer you, and
will show you great and difficult things,
which you don't know.'
4 For Yahweh, the God of Israel, says
concerning the houses of this city and
concerning the houses of the kings of
Judah, which are broken down to make a
defense against the mounds and against
the sword:
5 'While men come to fight with the
Chaldeans, and to fill them with the dead
bodies of men, whom I have killed in my
anger and in my wrath, and for all whose
wickedness I have hidden my face from
this city,
6 behold, I will bring it health and
healing, and I will cure them; and I will
reveal to them abundance of peace and
truth.
7 I will restore the fortunes of Judah and
Israel, and will build them as at the first.
8 I will cleanse them from all their
iniquity by which they have sinned
against me. I will pardon all their
iniquities by which they have sinned
against me and by which they have
transgressed against me.
9 This city will be to me for a name of
joy, for praise, and for glory, before all the
nations of the earth, which will hear all
the good that I do to them, and will fear

and tremble for all the good and for all the peace that I provide to it.' "

10 Yahweh says: "Yet again there will be heard in this place, about which you say, 'It is waste, without man and without animal, even in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, that are desolate, without man and without inhabitant and without animal,'
11 the voice of joy and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride, the voice of those who say, 'Give thanks to Yahweh of Armies, for Yahweh is good, for his loving kindness endures forever;' who bring thanksgiving into Yahweh's house. For I will cause the captivity of the land to be reversed as at the first," says Yahweh.

12 Yahweh of Armies says: "Yet again there will be in this place, which is waste, without man and without animal, and in all its cities, a habitation of shepherds causing their flocks to lie down.
13 In the cities of the hill country, in the cities of the lowland, in the cities of the South, in the land of Benjamin, in the places around Jerusalem, and in the cities of Judah, the flocks will again pass under the hands of him who counts them," says Yahweh.
14 "Behold, the days come," says Yahweh, "that I will perform that good word which I have spoken concerning the house of Israel and concerning the house of Judah.
15 "In those days and at that time,
I will cause a Branch of righteousness to grow up to David.
He will execute justice and righteousness in the land.
16 In those days Judah will be saved,
and Jerusalem will dwell safely.
This is the name by which she will be called:
Yahweh our righteousness."
17 For Yahweh says: "David will never lack a man to sit on the throne of the house of Israel.
18 The Levitical priests won't lack a man before me to offer burnt offerings, to burn meal offerings, and to do sacrifice continually."
19 Yahweh's word came to Jeremiah, saying,
20 "Yahweh says: 'If you can break my covenant of the day and my covenant of the night, so that there will not be day and night in their time,
21 then my covenant could also be broken with David my servant, that he won't have a son to reign on his throne; and with the Levitical priests, my ministers.
22 As the army of the sky can't be counted, and the sand of the sea can't be measured, so I will multiply the offspring of David my servant and the Levites who minister to me.' "
23 Yahweh's word came to Jeremiah, saying,
24 "Don't consider what this people has spoken, saying, 'Has Yahweh cast off the two families which he chose?' Thus they despise my people, that they should be no more a nation before them."
25 Yahweh says: "If my covenant of day and night fails, if I have not appointed the ordinances of heaven and earth,
26 then I will also cast away the offspring of Jacob, and of David my servant, so that I will not take of his offspring to be rulers over the offspring of Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob; for I will cause their captivity to be reversed and will have mercy on them."

34

1 The word which came to Jeremiah from Yahweh, when Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, with all his army, all the kingdoms of the earth that were under his dominion, and all the peoples, were fighting against Jerusalem and against all its cities, saying:
2 "Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, 'Go, and speak to Zedekiah king of Judah, and tell him, Yahweh says, "Behold, I will give this city into the hand of the king of Babylon and he will burn it with fire.
3 You won't escape out of his hand, but will surely be taken and delivered into his hand. Your eyes will see the eyes of the

king of Babylon, and he will speak with you mouth to mouth. You will go to Babylon.” ’
4 “Yet hear Yahweh’s word, O Zedekiah king of Judah. Yahweh says concerning you, ‘You won’t die by the sword.
5 You will die in peace; and with the burnings of your fathers, the former kings who were before you, so they will make a burning for you. They will lament you, saying, “Ah Lord!” for I have spoken the word,’ says Yahweh.”
6 Then Jeremiah the prophet spoke all these words to Zedekiah king of Judah in Jerusalem,
7 when the king of Babylon’s army was fighting against Jerusalem and against all the cities of Judah that were left, against Lachish and against Azekah; for these alone remained of the cities of Judah as fortified cities.
8 The word came to Jeremiah from Yahweh, after King Zedekiah had made a covenant with all the people who were at Jerusalem, to proclaim liberty to them,
9 that every man should let his male servant, and every man his female servant, who is a Hebrew or a Hebrewess, go free, that no one should make bondservants of them, of a Jew his brother.
10 All the princes and all the people obeyed who had entered into the covenant, that everyone should let his male servant and everyone his female servant go free, that no one should make bondservants of them any more. They obeyed and let them go,
11 but afterwards they turned, and caused the servants and the handmaids whom they had let go free to return, and brought them into subjection for servants and for handmaids.
12 Therefore Yahweh’s word came to Jeremiah from Yahweh, saying,
13 “Yahweh, the God of Israel, says: ‘I made a covenant with your fathers in the day that I brought them out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of bondage, saying:
14 At the end of seven years, every man of you shall release his brother who is a Hebrew, who has been sold to you, and has served you six years. You shall let him go free from you. But your fathers didn’t listen to me, and didn’t incline their ear.
15 You had now turned, and had done that which is right in my eyes, in every man proclaiming liberty to his neighbor. You had made a covenant before me in the house which is called by my name;
16 but you turned and profaned my name, and every man caused his servant and every man his handmaid, whom you had let go free at their pleasure, to return. You brought them into subjection, to be to you for servants and for handmaids.’ ”
17 Therefore Yahweh says: “You have not listened to me, to proclaim liberty, every man to his brother, and every man to his neighbor. Behold, I proclaim to you a liberty,” says Yahweh, “to the sword, to the pestilence, and to the famine. I will make you be tossed back and forth among all the kingdoms of the earth.
18 I will give the men who have transgressed my covenant, who have not performed the words of the covenant which they made before me when they cut the calf in two and passed between its parts:
19 the princes of Judah, the princes of Jerusalem, the eunuchs, the priests, and all the people of the land, who passed between the parts of the calf.
20 I will even give them into the hand of their enemies and into the hand of those who seek their life. Their dead bodies will be food for the birds of the sky and for the animals of the earth.
21 “I will give Zedekiah king of Judah and his princes into the hands of their enemies, into the hands of those who seek their life and into the hands of the king of Babylon’s army, who has gone away from you.
22 Behold, I will command,” says Yahweh, “and cause them to return to this city. They will fight against it, take it, and burn it with fire. I will make the cities of Judah a desolation, without inhabitant.”

35

1 The word which came to Jeremiah

from Yahweh in the days of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, saying,
2 "Go to the house of the Rechabites, and speak to them, and bring them into Yahweh's house, into one of the rooms, and give them wine to drink."

3 Then I took Jaazaniah the son of Jeremiah, the son of Habazziniah, with his brothers, all his sons, and the whole house of the Rechabites;
4 and I brought them into Yahweh's house, into the room of the sons of Hanan the son of Igdaliah, the man of God, which was by the room of the princes, which was above the room of Maaseiah the son of Shallum, the keeper of the threshold.
5 I set before the sons of the house of the Rechabites bowls full of wine, and cups; and I said to them, "Drink wine!"

6 But they said, "We will drink no wine; for Jonadab the son of Rechab, our father, commanded us, saying, 'You shall drink no wine, neither you nor your children, forever.
7 You shall not build a house, sow seed, plant a vineyard, or have any; but all your days you shall dwell in tents, that you may live many days in the land in which you live as nomads.'
8 We have obeyed the voice of Jonadab the son of Rechab, our father, in all that he commanded us, to drink no wine all our days, we, our wives, our sons, or our daughters;
9 and not to build houses for ourselves to dwell in. We have no vineyard, field, or seed;
10 but we have lived in tents, and have obeyed, and done according to all that Jonadab our father commanded us.
11 But when Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came up into the land, we said, 'Come! Let's go to Jerusalem for fear of the army of the Chaldeans, and for fear of the army of the Syrians; so we will dwell at Jerusalem.' "

12 Then Yahweh's word came to Jeremiah, saying,
13 "Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'Go and tell the men of Judah and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, "Will you not receive instruction to listen to my words?" says Yahweh.
14 "The words of Jonadab the son of Rechab that he commanded his sons, not to drink wine, are performed; and to this day they drink none, for they obey their father's commandment; but I have spoken to you, rising up early and speaking, and you have not listened to me.
15 I have sent also to you all my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them, saying, 'Every one of you must return now from his evil way, amend your doings, and don't go after other gods to serve them. Then you will dwell in the land which I have given to you and to your fathers;' but you have not inclined your ear, nor listened to me.
16 The sons of Jonadab the son of Rechab have performed the commandment of their father which he commanded them, but this people has not listened to me." '
17 "Therefore Yahweh, the God of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold, I will bring on Judah and on all the inhabitants of Jerusalem all the evil that I have pronounced against them, because I have spoken to them, but they have not heard; and I have called to them, but they have not answered.' "
18 Jeremiah said to the house of the Rechabites, "Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'Because you have obeyed the commandment of Jonadab your father, and kept all his precepts, and done according to all that he commanded you,'
19 therefore Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'Jonadab the son of Rechab will not lack a man to stand before me forever.' "

36

1 In the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, this word came to Jeremiah from Yahweh, saying,
2 "Take a scroll of a book, and write in it all the words that I have spoken to you against Israel, against Judah, and against all the nations, from the day I spoke to you, from the days of Josiah even to this day.

3 It may be that the house of Judah will
hear all the evil which I intend to do to
them, that they may each return from his
evil way; that I may forgive their iniquity
and their sin."
4 Then Jeremiah called Baruch the son
of Neriah; and Baruch wrote from the
mouth of Jeremiah all Yahweh's words,
which he had spoken to him, on a scroll of
a book.
5 Jeremiah commanded Baruch, saying,
"I am restricted. I can't go into Yahweh's
house.
6 Therefore you go, and read from the
scroll which you have written from my
mouth, Yahweh's words, in the ears of the
people in Yahweh's house on the fast day.
Also you shall read them in the ears of all
Judah who come out of their cities.
7 It may be they will present their
supplication before Yahweh, and will
each return from his evil way; for Yahweh
has pronounced great anger and wrath
against this people."
8 Baruch the son of Neriah did
according to all that Jeremiah the prophet
commanded him, reading in the book
Yahweh's words in Yahweh's house.
9 Now in the fifth year of Jehoiakim the
son of Josiah, king of Judah, in the ninth
month, all the people in Jerusalem and all
the people who came from the cities of
Judah to Jerusalem, proclaimed a fast
before Yahweh.
10 Then Baruch read the words of
Jeremiah from the book in Yahweh's
house, in the room of Gemariah the son of
Shaphan the scribe, in the upper court, at
the entry of the new gate of Yahweh's
house, in the ears of all the people.
11 When Micaiah the son of Gemariah,
the son of Shaphan, had heard out of the
book all Yahweh's words,
12 he went down into the king's house,
into the scribe's room; and behold, all the
princes were sitting there, Elishama the
scribe, Delaiah the son of Shemaiah,
Elnathan the son of Achbor, Gemariah the
son of Shaphan, Zedekiah the son of
Hananiah, and all the princes.
13 Then Micaiah declared to them all the
words that he had heard, when Baruch
read the book in the ears of the people.
14 Therefore all the princes sent Jehudi
the son of Nethaniah, the son of
Shelemiah, the son of Cushi, to Baruch,
saying, "Take in your hand the scroll in
which you have read in the ears of the
people, and come."

So Baruch the son of Neriah took the
scroll in his hand, and came to them.
15 They said to him, "Sit down now, and
read it in our hearing."

So Baruch read it in their hearing.

16 Now when they had heard all the
words, they turned in fear one toward
another, and said to Baruch, "We will
surely tell the king of all these words."
17 They asked Baruch, saying, "Tell us
now, how did you write all these words at
his mouth?"
18 Then Baruch answered them, "He
dictated all these words to me with his
mouth, and I wrote them with ink in the
book."
19 Then the princes said to Baruch, "You
and Jeremiah go hide. Don't let anyone
know where you are."
20 They went in to the king into the
court, but they had laid up the scroll in the
room of Elishama the scribe. Then they
told all the words in the hearing of the
king.
21 So the king sent Jehudi to get the
scroll, and he took it out of the room of
Elishama the scribe. Jehudi read it in the
hearing of the king, and in the hearing of
all the princes who stood beside the king.
22 Now the king was sitting in the winter
house in the ninth month, and there was a
fire in the brazier burning before him.
23 When Jehudi had read three or four
columns, the king cut it with the penknife,
and cast it into the fire that was in the
brazier, until all the scroll was consumed
in the fire that was in the brazier.
24 The king and his servants who heard
all these words were not afraid, and didn't
tear their garments.
25 Moreover Elnathan and Delaiah and
Gemariah had made intercession to the
king that he would not burn the scroll; but
he would not listen to them.

26 The king commanded Jerahmeel the king's son, and Seraiah the son of Azriel, and Shelemiah the son of Abdeel, to arrest Baruch the scribe and Jeremiah the prophet; but Yahweh hid them.

27 Then Yahweh's word came to Jeremiah, after the king had burned the scroll, and the words which Baruch wrote at the mouth of Jeremiah, saying,

28 "Take again another scroll, and write in it all the former words that were in the first scroll, which Jehoiakim the king of Judah has burned.

29 Concerning Jehoiakim king of Judah you shall say, 'Yahweh says: "You have burned this scroll, saying, 'Why have you written therein, saying, "The king of Babylon will certainly come and destroy this land, and will cause to cease from there man and animal"?' "

30 Therefore Yahweh says concerning Jehoiakim king of Judah: "He will have no one to sit on David's throne. His dead body will be cast out in the day to the heat, and in the night to the frost.

31 I will punish him, his offspring, and his servants for their iniquity. I will bring on them, on the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and on the men of Judah, all the evil that I have pronounced against them, but they didn't listen." ' "

32 Then Jeremiah took another scroll, and gave it to Baruch the scribe, the son of Neriah, who wrote therein from the mouth of Jeremiah all the words of the book which Jehoiakim king of Judah had burned in the fire; and many similar words were added to them.

37

1 Zedekiah the son of Josiah reigned as king instead of Coniah the son of Jehoiakim, whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon made king in the land of Judah.

2 But neither he, nor his servants, nor the people of the land, listened to Yahweh's words, which he spoke by the prophet Jeremiah.

3 Zedekiah the king sent Jehucal the son of Shelemiah and Zephaniah the son of Maaseiah, the priest, to the prophet Jeremiah, saying, "Pray now to Yahweh our God for us."

4 Now Jeremiah came in and went out among the people, for they had not put him into prison.

5 Pharaoh's army had come out of Egypt; and when the Chaldeans who were besieging Jerusalem heard news of them, they withdrew from Jerusalem.

6 Then Yahweh's word came to the prophet Jeremiah, saying,

7 "Yahweh, the God of Israel, says, 'You shall tell the king of Judah, who sent you to me to inquire of me: "Behold, Pharaoh's army, which has come out to help you, will return to Egypt into their own land.

8 The Chaldeans will come again, and fight against this city. They will take it and burn it with fire." '

9 "Yahweh says, 'Don't deceive yourselves, saying, "The Chaldeans will surely depart from us;" for they will not depart.

10 For though you had struck the whole army of the Chaldeans who fight against you, and only wounded men remained among them, they would each rise up in his tent and burn this city with fire.' "

11 When the army of the Chaldeans had withdrawn from Jerusalem for fear of Pharaoh's army,

12 then Jeremiah went out of Jerusalem to go into the land of Benjamin, to receive his portion there, in the middle of the people.

13 When he was in Benjamin's gate, a captain of the guard was there, whose name was Irijah, the son of Shelemiah, the son of Hananiah; and he seized Jeremiah the prophet, saying, "You are defecting to the Chaldeans!"

14 Then Jeremiah said, "That is false! I am not defecting to the Chaldeans."

But he didn't listen to him; so Irijah seized Jeremiah, and brought him to the princes.

15 The princes were angry with Jeremiah, and struck him, and put him in prison in the house of Jonathan the scribe; for they had made that the prison.

16 When Jeremiah had come into the
dungeon house and into the cells, and
Jeremiah had remained there many days,
17 then Zedekiah the king sent and had
him brought out. The king asked him
secretly in his house, "Is there any word
from Yahweh?"
Jeremiah said, "There is." He also said,
"You will be delivered into the hand of the
king of Babylon."
18 Moreover Jeremiah said to King
Zedekiah, "How have I sinned against
you, against your servants, or against this
people, that you have put me in prison?
19 Now where are your prophets who
prophesied to you, saying, 'The king of
Babylon will not come against you, nor
against this land'?
20 Now please hear, my lord the king:
please let my supplication be presented
before you, that you not cause me to
return to the house of Jonathan the scribe,
lest I die there."
21 Then Zedekiah the king commanded,
and they committed Jeremiah into the
court of the guard. They gave him daily a
loaf of bread out of the bakers' street,
until all the bread in the city was gone.
Thus Jeremiah remained in the court of
the guard.

38

1 Shephatiah the son of Mattan,
Gedaliah the son of Pashhur, Jucal the son
of Shelemiah, and Pashhur the son of
Malchijah heard the words that Jeremiah
spoke to all the people, saying,
2 "Yahweh says, 'He who remains in this
city will die by the sword, by the famine,
and by the pestilence, but he who goes out
to the Chaldeans will live. He will escape
with his life and he will live.'
3 Yahweh says, 'This city will surely be
given into the hand of the army of the
king of Babylon, and he will take it.' "
4 Then the princes said to the king,
"Please let this man be put to death,
because he weakens the hands of the men
of war who remain in this city, and the
hands of all the people, in speaking such
words to them; for this man doesn't seek
the welfare of this people, but harm."
5 Zedekiah the king said, "Behold, he is
in your hand; for the king can't do
anything to oppose you."
6 Then they took Jeremiah and threw
him into the dungeon of Malchijah the
king's son, that was in the court of the
guard. They let down Jeremiah with
cords. In the dungeon there was no water,
but mire; and Jeremiah sank in the mire.
7 Now when Ebedmelech the Ethiopian,
a eunuch, who was in the king's house,
heard that they had put Jeremiah in the
dungeon (the king was then sitting in
Benjamin's gate),
8 Ebedmelech went out of the king's
house, and spoke to the king, saying,
9 "My lord the king, these men have
done evil in all that they have done to
Jeremiah the prophet, whom they have
cast into the dungeon. He is likely to die in
the place where he is, because of the
famine; for there is no more bread in the
city."
10 Then the king commanded
Ebedmelech the Ethiopian, saying, "Take
from here thirty men with you, and take
up Jeremiah the prophet out of the
dungeon, before he dies."
11 So Ebedmelech took the men with
him, and went into the house of the king
under the treasury, and took from there
rags and worn-out garments, and let them
down by cords into the dungeon to
Jeremiah.
12 Ebedmelech the Ethiopian said to
Jeremiah, "Now put these rags and
worn-out garments under your armpits
under the cords."
Jeremiah did so.
13 So they lifted Jeremiah up with the
cords, and took him up out of the
dungeon; and Jeremiah remained in the
court of the guard.
14 Then Zedekiah the king sent and took
Jeremiah the prophet to himself into the
third entry that is in Yahweh's house.
Then the king said to Jeremiah, "I will ask
you something. Hide nothing from me."

15 Then Jeremiah said to Zedekiah, “If I
declare it to you, will you not surely put
me to death? If I give you counsel, you will
not listen to me.”
16 So Zedekiah the king swore secretly
to Jeremiah, saying, “As Yahweh lives,
who made our souls, I will not put you to
death, neither will I give you into the
hand of these men who seek your life.”
17 Then Jeremiah said to Zedekiah,
“Yahweh, the God of Armies, the God of
Israel, says: ‘If you will go out to the king
of Babylon’s princes, then your soul will
live, and this city will not be burned with
fire. You will live, along with your house.
18 But if you will not go out to the king of
Babylon’s princes, then this city will be
given into the hand of the Chaldeans, and
they will burn it with fire, and you won’t
escape out of their hand.’ ”
19 Zedekiah the king said to Jeremiah, “I
am afraid of the Jews who have defected
to the Chaldeans, lest they deliver me into
their hand, and they mock me.”
20 But Jeremiah said, “They won’t
deliver you. Obey, I beg you, Yahweh’s
voice, in that which I speak to you; so it
will be well with you, and your soul will
live.
21 But if you refuse to go out, this is the
word that Yahweh has shown me:
22 ‘Behold, all the women who are left in
the king of Judah’s house will be brought
out to the king of Babylon’s princes, and
those women will say,
“Your familiar friends have turned on
you,
and have prevailed over you.
Your feet are sunk in the mire,
they have turned away from you.”
23 They will bring out all your wives and
your children to the Chaldeans. You won’t
escape out of their hand, but will be taken
by the hand of the king of Babylon. You
will cause this city to be burned with
fire.’ ”
24 Then Zedekiah said to Jeremiah, “Let
no man know of these words, and you
won’t die.
25 But if the princes hear that I have
talked with you, and they come to you,
and tell you, ‘Declare to us now what you
have said to the king; don’t hide it from us,
and we will not put you to death; also tell
us what the king said to you;’
26 then you shall tell them, ‘I presented
my supplication before the king, that he
would not cause me to return to
Jonathan’s house, to die there.’ ”
27 Then all the princes came to
Jeremiah, and asked him; and he told
them according to all these words that the
king had commanded. So they stopped
speaking with him, for the matter was not
perceived.
28 So Jeremiah stayed in the court of the
guard until the day that Jerusalem was
taken.

39

1 In the ninth year of Zedekiah king of
Judah, in the tenth month,
Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon and all
his army came against Jerusalem, and
besieged it.
2 In the eleventh year of Zedekiah, in
the fourth month, the ninth day of the
month, a breach was made in the city.
3 All the princes of the king of Babylon
came in, and sat in the middle gate:
Nergal Sharezer, Samgarnebo, Sarsechim
the Rabsaris, Nergal Sharezer the
Rabmag, with all the rest of the princes of
the king of Babylon.
4 When Zedekiah the king of Judah and
all the men of war saw them, then they
fled and went out of the city by night, by
the way of the king’s garden, through the
gate between the two walls; and he went
out toward the Arabah.
5 But the army of the Chaldeans pursued
them, and overtook Zedekiah in the plains
of Jericho. When they had taken him, they
brought him up to Nebuchadnezzar king
of Babylon to Riblah in the land of
Hamath; and he pronounced judgment on
him.
6 Then the king of Babylon killed
Zedekiah’s sons in Riblah before his eyes.
The king of Babylon also killed all the
nobles of Judah.

7 Moreover he put out Zedekiah's eyes
and bound him in fetters, to carry him to
Babylon.
8 The Chaldeans burned the king's
house and the people's houses with fire
and broke down the walls of Jerusalem.
9 Then Nebuzaradan the captain of the
guard carried away captive into Babylon
the rest of the people who remained in the
city, the deserters also who fell away to
him, and the rest of the people who
remained.
10 But Nebuzaradan the captain of the
guard left of the poor of the people, who
had nothing, in the land of Judah, and
gave them vineyards and fields at the
same time.
11 Now Nebuchadnezzar king of
Babylon commanded Nebuzaradan the
captain of the guard concerning Jeremiah,
saying,
12 "Take him and take care of him. Do
him no harm; but do to him even as he
tells you."
13 So Nebuzaradan the captain of the
guard, Nebushazban, Rabsaris, and
Nergal Sharezer, Rabmag, and all the
chief officers of the king of Babylon
14 sent and took Jeremiah out of the
court of the guard, and committed him to
Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of
Shaphan, that he should bring him home.
So he lived among the people.
15 Now Yahweh's word came to
Jeremiah while he was shut up in the
court of the guard, saying,
16 "Go, and speak to Ebedmelech the
Ethiopian, saying, 'Yahweh of Armies, the
God of Israel, says: "Behold, I will bring
my words on this city for evil, and not for
good; and they will be accomplished
before you in that day.
17 But I will deliver you in that day,"
says Yahweh; "and you will not be given
into the hand of the men of whom you are
afraid.
18 For I will surely save you. You won't
fall by the sword, but you will escape with
your life, because you have put your trust
in me," says Yahweh.' "

40

1 The word which came to Jeremiah
from Yahweh, after Nebuzaradan the
captain of the guard had let him go from
Ramah, when he had taken him being
bound in chains among all the captives of
Jerusalem and Judah who were carried
away captive to Babylon.
2 The captain of the guard took
Jeremiah and said to him, "Yahweh your
God pronounced this evil on this place;
3 and Yahweh has brought it, and done
according as he spoke. Because you have
sinned against Yahweh, and have not
obeyed his voice, therefore this thing has
come on you.
4 Now, behold, I release you today from
the chains which are on your hand. If it
seems good to you to come with me into
Babylon, come, and I will take care of you;
but if it seems bad to you to come with me
into Babylon, don't. Behold, all the land is
before you. Where it seems good and
right to you to go, go there."
5 Now while he had not yet gone back,
"Go back then," he said, "to Gedaliah the
son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan, whom
the king of Babylon has made governor
over the cities of Judah, and dwell with
him among the people; or go wherever it
seems right to you to go."
So the captain of the guard gave him
food and a present, and let him go.
6 Then Jeremiah went to Gedaliah the
son of Ahikam to Mizpah, and lived with
him among the people who were left in
the land.
7 Now when all the captains of the
forces who were in the fields, even they
and their men, heard that the king of
Babylon had made Gedaliah the son of
Ahikam governor in the land, and had
committed to him men, women, children,
and of the poorest of the land, of those
who were not carried away captive to
Babylon,
8 then Ishmael the son of Nethaniah,
and Johanan and Jonathan the sons of
Kareah, and Seraiah the son of
Tanhumeth, and the sons of Ephai the
Netophathite, and Jezaniah the son of the

Maacathite, they and their men came to Gedaliah to Mizpah.
9 Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan swore to them and to their men, saying, “Don’t be afraid to serve the Chaldeans. Dwell in the land, and serve the king of Babylon, and it will be well with you.
10 As for me, behold, I will dwell at Mizpah, to stand before the Chaldeans who will come to us; but you, gather wine and summer fruits and oil, and put them in your vessels, and dwell in your cities that you have taken.”
11 Likewise when all the Jews who were in Moab, and among the children of Ammon, and in Edom, and who were in all the countries, heard that the king of Babylon had left a remnant of Judah, and that he had set over them Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan,
12 then all the Jews returned out of all places where they were driven, and came to the land of Judah, to Gedaliah, to Mizpah, and gathered very much wine and summer fruits.
13 Moreover Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces who were in the fields, came to Gedaliah to Mizpah,
14 and said to him, “Do you know that Baalis the king of the children of Ammon has sent Ishmael the son of Nethaniah to take your life?”
But Gedaliah the son of Ahikam didn’t believe them.
15 Then Johanan the son of Kareah spoke to Gedaliah in Mizpah secretly, saying, “Please let me go, and I will kill Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and no man will know it. Why should he take your life, that all the Jews who are gathered to you should be scattered, and the remnant of Judah perish?”
16 But Gedaliah the son of Ahikam said to Johanan the son of Kareah, “You shall not do this thing, for you speak falsely of Ishmael.”

41

1 Now in the seventh month, Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, the son of Elishama, of the royal offspring and one of the chief officers of the king, and ten men with him, came to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam to Mizpah; and there they ate bread together in Mizpah.
2 Then Ishmael the son of Nethaniah arose, and the ten men who were with him, and struck Gedaliah the son of Ahikam the son of Shaphan with the sword and killed him, whom the king of Babylon had made governor over the land.
3 Ishmael also killed all the Jews who were with Gedaliah at Mizpah, and the Chaldean men of war who were found there.
4 The second day after he had killed Gedaliah, and no man knew it,
5 men came from Shechem, from Shiloh, and from Samaria, even eighty men, having their beards shaved and their clothes torn, and having cut themselves, with meal offerings and frankincense in their hand, to bring them to Yahweh’s house.
6 Ishmael the son of Nethaniah went out from Mizpah to meet them, weeping all along as he went, and as he met them, he said to them, “Come to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam.”
7 It was so, when they came into the middle of the city, that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah killed them, and cast them into the middle of the pit, he, and the men who were with him.
8 But ten men were found among those who said to Ishmael, “Don’t kill us; for we have stores hidden in the field, of wheat, and of barley, and of oil, and of honey.”
So he stopped, and didn’t kill them among their brothers.
9 Now the pit in which Ishmael cast all the dead bodies of the men whom he had killed, by the side of Gedaliah (this was that which Asa the king had made for fear of Baasha king of Israel), Ishmael the son of Nethaniah filled it with those who were killed.
10 Then Ishmael carried away captive all of the people who were left in Mizpah, even the king’s daughters, and all the people who remained in Mizpah, whom Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard

had committed to Gedaliah the son of Ahikam. Ishmael the son of Nethaniah carried them away captive, and departed to go over to the children of Ammon.

11 But when Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces who were with him, heard of all the evil that Ishmael the son of Nethaniah had done,
12 then they took all the men, and went to fight with Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, and found him by the great waters that are in Gibeon.
13 Now when all the people who were with Ishmael saw Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces who were with him, then they were glad.
14 So all the people who Ishmael had carried away captive from Mizpah turned about and came back, and went to Johanan the son of Kareah.
15 But Ishmael the son of Nethaniah escaped from Johanan with eight men, and went to the children of Ammon.
16 Then Johanan the son of Kareah and all the captains of the forces who were with him took all the remnant of the people whom he had recovered from Ishmael the son of Nethaniah, from Mizpah, after he had killed Gedaliah the son of Ahikam—the men of war, with the women, the children, and the eunuchs, whom he had brought back from Gibeon.
17 They departed and lived in Geruth Chimham, which is by Bethlehem, to go to enter into Egypt
18 because of the Chaldeans; for they were afraid of them, because Ishmael the son of Nethaniah had killed Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, whom the king of Babylon made governor over the land.

42

1 Then all the captains of the forces, and Johanan the son of Kareah, and Jezaniah the son of Hoshaiah, and all the people from the least even to the greatest, came near,
2 and said to Jeremiah the prophet, “Please let our supplication be presented before you, and pray for us to Yahweh your God, even for all this remnant, for we are left but a few of many, as your eyes see us,
3 that Yahweh your God may show us the way in which we should walk, and the things that we should do.”

4 Then Jeremiah the prophet said to them, “I have heard you. Behold, I will pray to Yahweh your God according to your words; and it will happen that whatever thing Yahweh answers you, I will declare it to you. I will keep nothing back from you.”

5 Then they said to Jeremiah, “May Yahweh be a true and faithful witness among us, if we don’t do according to all the word with which Yahweh your God sends you to tell us.
6 Whether it is good, or whether it is bad, we will obey the voice of Yahweh our God, to whom we send you; that it may be well with us, when we obey the voice of Yahweh our God.”
7 After ten days, Yahweh’s word came to Jeremiah.
8 Then he called Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces who were with him, and all the people from the least even to the greatest,
9 and said to them, “Yahweh, the God of Israel, to whom you sent me to present your supplication before him, says:
10 ‘If you will still live in this land, then I will build you, and not pull you down, and I will plant you, and not pluck you up; for I grieve over the distress that I have brought on you.
11 Don’t be afraid of the king of Babylon, of whom you are afraid. Don’t be afraid of him,’ says Yahweh, ‘for I am with you to save you, and to deliver you from his hand.
12 I will grant you mercy, that he may have mercy on you, and cause you to return to your own land.

13 “ ‘But if you say, “We will not dwell in this land,” so that you don’t obey Yahweh your God’s voice,
14 saying, “No, but we will go into the land of Egypt, where we will see no war, nor hear the sound of the trumpet, nor

have hunger of bread; and there we will dwell;" '
15 now therefore hear Yahweh's word, O remnant of Judah! Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says, 'If you indeed set your faces to enter into Egypt, and go to live there,
16 then it will happen that the sword, which you fear, will overtake you there in the land of Egypt; and the famine, about which you are afraid, will follow close behind you there in Egypt; and you will die there.
17 So will it be with all the men who set their faces to go into Egypt to live there. They will die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence. None of them will remain or escape from the evil that I will bring on them.'
18 For Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'As my anger and my wrath has been poured out on the inhabitants of Jerusalem, so my wrath will be poured out on you, when you enter into Egypt; and you will be an object of horror, an astonishment, a curse, and a reproach; and you will see this place no more.'
19 "Yahweh has spoken concerning you, remnant of Judah, 'Don't go into Egypt!' Know certainly that I have testified to you today.
20 For you have dealt deceitfully against your own souls; for you sent me to Yahweh your God, saying, 'Pray for us to Yahweh our God; and according to all that Yahweh our God says, so declare to us, and we will do it.'
21 I have declared it to you today; but you have not obeyed Yahweh your God's voice in anything for which he has sent me to you.
22 Now therefore know certainly that you will die by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence in the place where you desire to go to live."

43

1 When Jeremiah had finished speaking to all the people all the words of Yahweh their God, with which Yahweh their God had sent him to them, even all these words,
2 then Azariah the son of Hoshaiah, Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the proud men spoke, saying to Jeremiah, "You speak falsely. Yahweh our God has not sent you to say, 'You shall not go into Egypt to live there;'
3 but Baruch the son of Neriah has turned you against us, to deliver us into the hand of the Chaldeans, that they may put us to death or carry us away captive to Babylon."
4 So Johanan the son of Kareah, and all the captains of the forces, and all the people, didn't obey Yahweh's voice, to dwell in the land of Judah.
5 But Johanan the son of Kareah and all the captains of the forces took all the remnant of Judah, who had returned from all the nations where they had been driven, to live in the land of Judah—
6 the men, the women, the children, the king's daughters, and every person who Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard had left with Gedaliah the son of Ahikam, the son of Shaphan; and Jeremiah the prophet, and Baruch the son of Neriah.
7 They came into the land of Egypt, for they didn't obey Yahweh's voice; and they came to Tahpanhes.
8 Then Yahweh's word came to Jeremiah in Tahpanhes, saying,
9 "Take great stones in your hand and hide them in mortar in the brick work which is at the entry of Pharaoh's house in Tahpanhes, in the sight of the men of Judah.
10 Tell them, Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold, I will send and take Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant, and will set his throne on these stones that I have hidden; and he will spread his royal pavilion over them.
11 He will come, and will strike the land of Egypt; such as are for death will be put to death, and such as are for captivity to captivity, and such as are for the sword to the sword.
12 I will kindle a fire in the houses of the gods of Egypt. He will burn them, and carry them away captive. He will array himself with the land of Egypt, as a

shepherd puts on his garment; and he will go out from there in peace.
13 He will also break the pillars of Beth Shemesh that is in the land of Egypt; and he will burn the houses of the gods of Egypt with fire.' "

44

1 The word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the Jews who lived in the land of Egypt, who lived at Migdol, and at Tahpanhes, and at Memphis, and in the country of Pathros, saying,
2 "Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'You have seen all the evil that I have brought on Jerusalem, and on all the cities of Judah. Behold, today they are a desolation, and no man dwells in them,
3 because of their wickedness which they have committed to provoke me to anger, in that they went to burn incense, to serve other gods that they didn't know, neither they, nor you, nor your fathers.
4 However I sent to you all my servants the prophets, rising up early and sending them, saying, "Oh, don't do this abominable thing that I hate."
5 But they didn't listen and didn't incline their ear. They didn't turn from their wickedness, to stop burning incense to other gods.
6 Therefore my wrath and my anger was poured out, and was kindled in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem; and they are wasted and desolate, as it is today.'
7 "Therefore now Yahweh, the God of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'Why do you commit great evil against your own souls, to cut off from yourselves man and woman, infant and nursing child out of the middle of Judah, to leave yourselves no one remaining,
8 in that you provoke me to anger with the works of your hands, burning incense to other gods in the land of Egypt where you have gone to live, that you may be cut off, and that you may be a curse and a reproach among all the nations of the earth?
9 Have you forgotten the wickedness of your fathers, the wickedness of the kings of Judah, the wickedness of their wives, your own wickedness, and the wickedness of your wives which they committed in the land of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem?
10 They are not humbled even to this day, neither have they feared, nor walked in my law, nor in my statutes, that I set before you and before your fathers.'
11 "Therefore Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says: 'Behold, I will set my face against you for evil, even to cut off all Judah.
12 I will take the remnant of Judah that have set their faces to go into the land of Egypt to live there, and they will all be consumed. They will fall in the land of Egypt. They will be consumed by the sword and by the famine. They will die, from the least even to the greatest, by the sword and by the famine. They will be an object of horror, an astonishment, a curse, and a reproach.
13 For I will punish those who dwell in the land of Egypt, as I have punished Jerusalem, by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence;
14 so that none of the remnant of Judah, who have gone into the land of Egypt to live there, will escape or be left to return into the land of Judah, to which they have a desire to return to dwell there; for no one will return except those who will escape.' "
15 Then all the men who knew that their wives burned incense to other gods, and all the women who stood by, a great assembly, even all the people who lived in the land of Egypt, in Pathros, answered Jeremiah, saying,
16 "As for the word that you have spoken to us in Yahweh's name, we will not listen to you.
17 But we will certainly perform every word that has gone out of our mouth, to burn incense to the queen of the sky and to pour out drink offerings to her, as we have done, we and our fathers, our kings

and our princes, in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem; for then we had plenty of food, and were well, and saw no evil.
18 But since we stopped burning incense to the queen of the sky, and pouring out drink offerings to her, we have lacked all things, and have been consumed by the sword and by the famine."

19 The women said, "When we burned incense to the queen of the sky and poured out drink offerings to her, did we make her cakes to worship her, and pour out drink offerings to her, without our husbands?"

20 Then Jeremiah said to all the people—to the men and to the women, even to all the people who had given him an answer, saying,
21 "The incense that you burned in the cities of Judah, and in the streets of Jerusalem, you and your fathers, your kings and your princes, and the people of the land, didn't Yahweh remember them, and didn't it come into his mind?
22 Thus Yahweh could no longer bear it, because of the evil of your doings and because of the abominations which you have committed. Therefore your land has become a desolation, an astonishment, and a curse, without inhabitant, as it is today.
23 Because you have burned incense and because you have sinned against Yahweh, and have not obeyed Yahweh's voice, nor walked in his law, nor in his statutes, nor in his testimonies; therefore this evil has happened to you, as it is today."

24 Moreover Jeremiah said to all the people, including all the women, "Hear Yahweh's word, all Judah who are in the land of Egypt!
25 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, says, 'You and your wives have both spoken with your mouths, and with your hands have fulfilled it, saying, "We will surely perform our vows that we have vowed, to burn incense to the queen of the sky, and to pour out drink offerings to her."

" 'Establish then your vows, and perform your vows.'
26 "Therefore hear Yahweh's word, all Judah who dwell in the land of Egypt: 'Behold, I have sworn by my great name,' says Yahweh, 'that my name will no more be named in the mouth of any man of Judah in all the land of Egypt, saying, "As the Lord Yahweh lives."
27 Behold, I watch over them for evil, and not for good; and all the men of Judah who are in the land of Egypt will be consumed by the sword and by the famine, until they are all gone.
28 Those who escape the sword will return out of the land of Egypt into the land of Judah few in number. All the remnant of Judah, who have gone into the land of Egypt to live there, will know whose word will stand, mine or theirs.
29 " 'This will be the sign to you,' says Yahweh, 'that I will punish you in this place, that you may know that my words will surely stand against you for evil.'
30 Yahweh says, 'Behold, I will give Pharaoh Hophra king of Egypt into the hand of his enemies and into the hand of those who seek his life, just as I gave Zedekiah king of Judah into the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon, who was his enemy and sought his life.' "

45

1 The message that Jeremiah the prophet spoke to Baruch the son of Neriah, when he wrote these words in a book at the mouth of Jeremiah, in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah, saying,
2 "Yahweh, the God of Israel, says to you, Baruch:
3 'You said, "Woe is me now! For Yahweh has added sorrow to my pain! I am weary with my groaning, and I find no rest." '
4 "You shall tell him, Yahweh says: 'Behold, that which I have built, I will break down, and that which I have planted I will pluck up; and this in the whole land.
5 Do you seek great things for yourself? Don't seek them; for, behold, I will bring evil on all flesh,' says Yahweh, 'but I will

let you escape with your life wherever
you go.' "

46

1 Yahweh's word which came to
Jeremiah the prophet concerning the
nations.
2 Of Egypt: concerning the army of
Pharaoh Necoh king of Egypt, which was
by the river Euphrates in Carchemish,
which Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon
struck in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the
son of Josiah, king of Judah.
3 "Prepare the buckler and shield,
and draw near to battle!
4 Harness the horses, and get up, you
horsemen,
and stand up with your helmets.
Polish the spears,
put on the coats of mail.
5 Why have I seen it?
They are dismayed and are turned
backward.
Their mighty ones are beaten down,
have fled in haste,
and don't look back.
Terror is on every side,"
says Yahweh.
6 "Don't let the swift flee away,
nor the mighty man escape.
In the north by the river Euphrates
they have stumbled and fallen.

7 "Who is this who rises up like the Nile,
like rivers whose waters surge?
8 Egypt rises up like the Nile,
like rivers whose waters surge.
He says, 'I will rise up. I will cover the
earth.
I will destroy cities and its
inhabitants.'
9 Go up, you horses!
Rage, you chariots!
Let the mighty men go out:
Cush and Put, who handle the shield;
and the Ludim, who handle and bend
the bow.
10 For that day is of the Lord, Yahweh of
Armies,
a day of vengeance,
that he may avenge himself of his
adversaries.
The sword will devour and be satiated,
and will drink its fill of their blood;
for the Lord, Yahweh of Armies, has a
sacrifice in the north country by the
river Euphrates.
11 Go up into Gilead, and take balm, virgin
daughter of Egypt.
You use many medicines in vain.
There is no healing for you.
12 The nations have heard of your shame,
and the earth is full of your cry;
for the mighty man has stumbled
against the mighty,
they both fall together."

13 The word that Yahweh spoke to
Jeremiah the prophet, how that
Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon should
come and strike the land of Egypt:
14 "Declare in Egypt,
publish in Migdol,
and publish in Memphis and in
Tahpanhes;
say, 'Stand up, and prepare,
for the sword has devoured around
you.'
15 Why are your strong ones swept away?
They didn't stand, because Yahweh
pushed them.
16 He made many to stumble.
Yes, they fell on one another.
They said, 'Arise! Let's go again to our
own people,
and to the land of our birth,
from the oppressing sword.'
17 They cried there, 'Pharaoh king of Egypt
is but a noise;
he has let the appointed time pass by.'

18 "As I live," says the King,
whose name is Yahweh of Armies,
"surely like Tabor among the mountains,
and like Carmel by the sea,
so he will come.
19 You daughter who dwells in Egypt,
furnish yourself to go into captivity;
for Memphis will become a desolation,
and will be burned up,
without inhabitant.

20 "Egypt is a very beautiful heifer;
but destruction out of the north has
come.

It has come.
21 Also her hired men in the middle of her
are like calves of the stall,
for they also are turned back.
They have fled away together.
They didn't stand,
for the day of their calamity has come
on them,
the time of their visitation.
22 Its sound will go like the serpent,
for they will march with an army,
and come against her with axes, as
wood cutters.
23 They will cut down her forest," says
Yahweh,
"though it can't be searched;
because they are more than the locusts,
and are innumerable.
24 The daughter of Egypt will be
disappointed;
she will be delivered into the hand of
the people of the north."
25 Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel,
says: "Behold, I will punish Amon of No,
and Pharaoh, and Egypt, with her gods
and her kings, even Pharaoh, and those
who trust in him.
26 I will deliver them into the hand of
those who seek their lives, and into the
hand of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon,
and into the hand of his servants.
Afterwards it will be inhabited, as in the
days of old," says Yahweh.
27 "But don't you be afraid, Jacob my
servant.
Don't be dismayed, Israel;
for, behold, I will save you from afar,
and your offspring from the land of
their captivity.
Jacob will return,
and will be quiet and at ease.
No one will make him afraid.
28 Don't be afraid, O Jacob my servant,"
says Yahweh,
"for I am with you;
for I will make a full end of all the
nations where I have driven you,
but I will not make a full end of you,
but I will correct you in measure,
and will in no way leave you
unpunished."

47

1 Yahweh's word that came to Jeremiah
the prophet concerning the Philistines,
before Pharaoh struck Gaza.
2 Yahweh says:
"Behold, waters rise up out of the north,
and will become an overflowing
stream,
and will overflow the land and all that is
therein,
the city and those who dwell therein.
The men will cry,
and all the inhabitants of the land will
wail.
3 At the noise of the stamping of the hoofs
of his strong ones,
at the rushing of his chariots,
at the rumbling of his wheels,
the fathers don't look back for their
children
because their hands are so feeble,
4 because of the day that comes to destroy
all the Philistines,
to cut off from Tyre and Sidon every
helper who remains;
for Yahweh will destroy the Philistines,
the remnant of the isle of Caphtor.
5 Baldness has come on Gaza;
Ashkelon is brought to nothing.
You remnant of their valley,
how long will you cut yourself?

6 " 'You sword of Yahweh, how long will it
be before you are quiet?
Put yourself back into your scabbard;
rest, and be still.'

7 "How can you be quiet,
since Yahweh has given you a
command?
Against Ashkelon, and against the
seashore,
there he has appointed it."

48

1 Of Moab. Yahweh of Armies, the God
of Israel, says:
"Woe to Nebo!
For it is laid waste.
Kiriathaim is disappointed.
It is taken.
Misgab† is put to shame

† **48:1** or, The stronghold

and broken down.
2 The praise of Moab is no more.
In Heshbon they have devised evil
against her:
'Come! Let's cut her off from being a
nation.'
You also, Madmen, will be brought to
silence.
The sword will pursue you.
3 The sound of a cry from Horonaim,
desolation and great destruction!
4 Moab is destroyed.
Her little ones have caused a cry to be
heard.
5 For they will go up by the ascent of
Luhith with continual weeping.
For at the descent of Horonaim they
have heard the distress of the cry of
destruction.
6 Flee! Save your lives!
Be like the juniper bush in the
wilderness.
7 For, because you have trusted in your
works and in your treasures,
you also will be taken.
Chemosh will go out into captivity,
his priests and his princes together.
8 The destroyer will come on every city,
and no city will escape;
the valley also will perish,
and the plain will be destroyed, as
Yahweh has spoken.
9 Give wings to Moab,
that she may fly and get herself away:
and her cities will become a desolation,
without anyone to dwell in them.

10 "Cursed is he who does the work of
Yahweh negligently;
and cursed is he who keeps back his
sword from blood.

11 "Moab has been at ease from his youth,
and he has settled on his dregs,
and has not been emptied from vessel to
vessel,
neither has he gone into captivity;
therefore his taste remains in him,
and his scent is not changed.
12 Therefore behold, the days come," says
Yahweh,
"that I will send to him those who
pour off,
and they will pour him off;
and they will empty his vessels,
and break their containers in pieces.
13 Moab will be ashamed of Chemosh,
as the house of Israel was ashamed of
Bethel, their confidence.

14 "How do you say, 'We are mighty men,
and valiant men for the war'?
15 Moab is laid waste,
and they have gone up into his cities,
and his chosen young men have gone
down to the slaughter,"
says the King, whose name is Yahweh
of Armies.
16 "The calamity of Moab is near to come,
and his affliction hurries fast.
17 All you who are around him, bemoan
him;
and all you who know his name, say,
'How the strong staff is broken,
the beautiful rod!'

18 "You daughter who dwells in Dibon,
come down from your glory,
and sit in thirst;
for the destroyer of Moab has come up
against you.
He has destroyed your strongholds.
19 Inhabitant of Aroer, stand by the way
and watch.
Ask him who flees, and her who
escapes;
say, 'What has been done?'
20 Moab is disappointed;
for it is broken down.
Wail and cry!
Tell it by the Arnon, that Moab is laid
waste.
21 Judgment has come on the plain
country—
on Holon, on Jahzah, on Mephaath,
22 on Dibon, on Nebo, on Beth
Diblathaim,
23 on Kiriathaim, on Beth Gamul, on
Beth Meon,
24 on Kerioth, on Bozrah,
and on all the cities of the land of
Moab, far or near.
25 The horn of Moab is cut off,
and his arm is broken," says Yahweh.

26 “Make him drunk,
for he magnified himself against Yahweh.
Moab will wallow in his vomit,
and he also will be in derision.
27 For wasn’t Israel a derision to you?
Was he found among thieves?
For as often as you speak of him,
you shake your head.
28 You inhabitants of Moab, leave the cities, and dwell in the rock.
Be like the dove that makes her nest over the mouth of the abyss.

29 “We have heard of the pride of Moab.
He is very proud in his loftiness, his pride,
his arrogance, and the arrogance of his heart.
30 I know his wrath,” says Yahweh, “that it is nothing;
his boastings have done nothing.
31 Therefore I will wail for Moab.
Yes, I will cry out for all Moab.
They will mourn for the men of Kir Heres.
32 With more than the weeping of Jazer
I will weep for you, vine of Sibmah.
Your branches passed over the sea.
They reached even to the sea of Jazer.
The destroyer has fallen on your summer fruits
and on your vintage.
33 Gladness and joy is taken away from the fruitful field
and from the land of Moab.
I have caused wine to cease from the wine presses.
No one will tread with shouting.
The shouting will be no shouting.
34 From the cry of Heshbon even to Elealeh,
even to Jahaz they have uttered their voice,
from Zoar even to Horonaim, to Eglath Shelishiyah;
for the waters of Nimrim will also become desolate.
35 Moreover I will cause to cease in Moab,” says Yahweh,
“him who offers in the high place,
and him who burns incense to his gods.
36 Therefore my heart sounds for Moab like flutes,
and my heart sounds like flutes for the men of Kir Heres.
Therefore the abundance that he has gotten has perished.
37 For every head is bald,
and every beard clipped.
There are cuttings on all the hands,
and sackcloth on the waist.
38 On all the housetops of Moab,
and in its streets, there is lamentation everywhere;
for I have broken Moab like a vessel in which no one delights,” says Yahweh.
39 “How it is broken down!
How they wail!
How Moab has turned the back with shame!
So will Moab become a derision
and a terror to all who are around him.”
40 For Yahweh says: “Behold, he will fly as an eagle,
and will spread out his wings against Moab.
41 Kerioth is taken,
and the strongholds are seized.
The heart of the mighty men of Moab at that day
will be as the heart of a woman in her pangs.
42 Moab will be destroyed from being a people,
because he has magnified himself against Yahweh.
43 Terror, the pit, and the snare are on you,
inhabitant of Moab,” says Yahweh.
44 “He who flees from the terror will fall into the pit;
and he who gets up out of the pit will be taken in the snare,
for I will bring on him, even on Moab,
the year of their visitation,” says Yahweh.

45 “Those who fled stand without strength under the shadow of Heshbon;
for a fire has gone out of Heshbon,
and a flame from the middle of Sihon,
and has devoured the corner of Moab,
and the crown of the head of the tumultuous ones.

46 Woe to you, O Moab!
The people of Chemosh are undone;
for your sons are taken away captive,
and your daughters into captivity.

47 "Yet I will reverse the captivity of Moab
in the latter days,"
says Yahweh.
Thus far is the judgment of Moab.

49

1 Of the children of Ammon. Yahweh says:
"Has Israel no sons?
Has he no heir?
Why then does Malcam possess Gad,
and his people dwell in its cities?
2 Therefore behold, the days come,"
says Yahweh,
"that I will cause an alarm of war to be
heard against Rabbah of the
children of Ammon,
and it will become a desolate heap,
and her daughters will be burned
with fire;
then Israel will possess those who
possessed him,"
says Yahweh.
3 "Wail, Heshbon, for Ai is laid waste!
Cry, you daughters of Rabbah!
Clothe yourself in sackcloth.
Lament, and run back and forth
among the fences;
for Malcam will go into captivity,
his priests and his princes together.
4 Why do you boast in the valleys,
your flowing valley, backsliding
daughter?
You trusted in her treasures,
saying, 'Who will come to me?'
5 Behold, I will bring a terror on you,"
says the Lord, Yahweh of Armies,
"from all who are around you.
All of you will be driven completely
out,
and there will be no one to gather
together the fugitives.

6 "But afterward I will reverse the
captivity of the children of
Ammon,"
says Yahweh.

7 Of Edom, Yahweh of Armies says:
"Is wisdom no more in Teman?
Has counsel perished from the
prudent?
Has their wisdom vanished?
8 Flee! Turn back!
Dwell in the depths, inhabitants of
Dedan;
for I will bring the calamity of Esau
on him when I visit him.
9 If grape gatherers came to you,
would they not leave some gleaning
grapes?
If thieves came by night,
wouldn't they steal until they had
enough?
10 But I have made Esau bare,
I have uncovered his secret places,
and he will not be able to hide
himself.
His offspring is destroyed,
with his brothers and his neighbors;
and he is no more.
11 Leave your fatherless children.
I will preserve them alive.
Let your widows trust in me."
12 For Yahweh says: "Behold, they to
whom it didn't pertain to drink of the cup
will certainly drink; and are you he who
will altogether go unpunished? You won't
go unpunished, but you will surely drink.
13 For I have sworn by myself," says
Yahweh, "that Bozrah will become an
astonishment, a reproach, a waste, and a
curse. All its cities will be perpetual
wastes."
14 I have heard news from Yahweh,
and an ambassador is sent among the
nations,
saying, "Gather yourselves together!
Come against her!
Rise up to the battle!"

15 "For, behold, I have made you small
among the nations,
and despised among men.
16 As for your terror,
the pride of your heart has deceived
you,
O you who dwell in the clefts of the rock,
who hold the height of the hill,

though you should make your nest as high
as the eagle,
I will bring you down from there,"
says Yahweh.
17 "Edom will become an astonishment.
Everyone who passes by it will be
astonished,
and will hiss at all its plagues.
18 As in the overthrow of Sodom and
Gomorrah and its neighbor cities,"
says Yahweh,
"no man will dwell there,
neither will any son of man live
therein.

19 "Behold, he will come up like a lion
from the pride of the Jordan against
the strong habitation;
for I will suddenly make them run
away from it,
and whoever is chosen,
I will appoint him over it.
For who is like me?
Who will appoint me a time?
Who is the shepherd who will stand
before me?"
20 Therefore hear the counsel of Yahweh,
that he has taken against Edom,
and his purposes that he has
purposed against the inhabitants of
Teman:
Surely they will drag them away,
the little ones of the flock.
Surely he will make their habitation
desolate over them.
21 The earth trembles at the noise of their
fall;
there is a cry, the noise which is
heard in the Red Sea.
22 Behold, he will come up and fly as the
eagle,
and spread out his wings against
Bozrah.
The heart of the mighty men of Edom
at that day will be as the heart of a
woman in her pangs.

23 Of Damascus:
"Hamath and Arpad are confounded,
for they have heard evil news.
They have melted away.
There is sorrow on the sea.
It can't be quiet.
24 Damascus has grown feeble,
she turns herself to flee,
and trembling has seized her.
Anguish and sorrows have taken hold of
her,
as of a woman in travail.
25 How is the city of praise not forsaken,
the city of my joy?
26 Therefore her young men will fall in
her streets,
and all the men of war will be
brought to silence in that day,"
says Yahweh of Armies.
27 "I will kindle a fire in the wall of
Damascus,
and it will devour the palaces of Ben
Hadad."

28 Of Kedar, and of the kingdoms of Hazor,
which Nebuchadnezzar king of
Babylon struck, Yahweh says:
"Arise, go up to Kedar,
and destroy the children of the east.
29 They will take their tents and their
flocks.
they will carry away for themselves
their curtains,
all their vessels, and their camels;
and they will cry to them, 'Terror on
every side!'
30 Flee!
Wander far off!
Dwell in the depths, you inhabitants of
Hazor," says Yahweh;
"for Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon
has taken counsel against you,
and has conceived a purpose against
you.
31 Arise! Go up to a nation that is at ease,
that dwells without care," says
Yahweh;
"that has neither gates nor bars,
that dwells alone.
32 Their camels will be a booty,
and the multitude of their livestock a
plunder.
I will scatter to all winds those who have
the corners of their beards cut off;
and I will bring their calamity from
every side of them,"
says Yahweh.
33 Hazor will be a dwelling place of
jackals,

a desolation forever.
No man will dwell there,
neither will any son of man live therein."

34 Yahweh's word that came to Jeremiah the prophet concerning Elam, in the beginning of the reign of Zedekiah king of Judah, saying,
35 "Yahweh of Armies says:
'Behold, I will break the bow of Elam,
the chief of their might.
36 I will bring on Elam the four winds
from the four quarters of the sky,
and will scatter them toward all those winds.
There will be no nation where the outcasts of Elam will not come.
37 I will cause Elam to be dismayed before their enemies,
and before those who seek their life.
I will bring evil on them, even my fierce anger,' says Yahweh;
'and I will send the sword after them,
until I have consumed them.
38 I will set my throne in Elam,
and will destroy from there king and princes,' says Yahweh.
39 'But it will happen in the latter days
that I will reverse the captivity of Elam,' says Yahweh."

50

1 The word that Yahweh spoke concerning Babylon, concerning the land of the Chaldeans, by Jeremiah the prophet.
2 "Declare among the nations and publish,
and set up a standard;
publish, and don't conceal;
say, 'Babylon has been taken,
Bel is disappointed,
Merodach is dismayed!
Her images are disappointed.
Her idols are dismayed.'
3 For a nation comes up out of the north against her,
which will make her land desolate,
and no one will dwell in it.
They have fled.
They are gone,
both man and animal.
4 "In those days, and in that time," says Yahweh,
"the children of Israel will come,
they and the children of Judah together;
they will go on their way weeping,
and will seek Yahweh their God.
5 They will inquire concerning Zion with their faces turned toward it,
saying, 'Come, and join yourselves to Yahweh in an everlasting covenant
that will not be forgotten.'
6 My people have been lost sheep.
Their shepherds have caused them to go astray.
They have turned them away on the mountains.
They have gone from mountain to hill.
They have forgotten their resting place.
7 All who found them have devoured them.
Their adversaries said, 'We are not guilty,
because they have sinned against Yahweh,
the habitation of righteousness,
even Yahweh, the hope of their fathers.'

8 "Flee out of the middle of Babylon!
Go out of the land of the Chaldeans,
and be as the male goats before the flocks.
9 For, behold, I will stir up
and cause to come up against Babylon
a company of great nations from the north country;
and they will set themselves in array against her.
She will be taken from there.
Their arrows will be as of an expert mighty man.
None of them will return in vain.
10 Chaldea will be a prey.
All who prey on her will be satisfied," says Yahweh.

11 "Because you are glad,
because you rejoice,
O you who plunder my heritage,

because you are wanton as a heifer
that treads out the grain,
and neigh as strong horses,
12 your mother will be utterly
disappointed.
She who bore you will be confounded.
Behold, she will be the least of the nations,
a wilderness, a dry land, and a desert.
13 Because of Yahweh's wrath she won't be
inhabited,
but she will be wholly desolate.
Everyone who goes by Babylon will be
astonished,
and hiss at all her plagues.
14 Set yourselves in array against Babylon
all around,
all you who bend the bow;
shoot at her.
Spare no arrows,
for she has sinned against Yahweh.
15 Shout against her all around.
She has submitted herself.
Her bulwarks have fallen.
Her walls have been thrown down,
for it is the vengeance of Yahweh.
Take vengeance on her.
As she has done, do to her.
16 Cut off the sower from Babylon,
and him who handles the sickle in the
time of harvest.
For fear of the oppressing sword,
they will each return to their own
people,
and they will each flee to their own
land.

17 "Israel is a hunted sheep.
The lions have driven him away.
First, the king of Assyria devoured him,
and now at last Nebuchadnezzar king
of Babylon has broken his bones."
18 Therefore Yahweh of Armies, the God
of Israel, says:
"Behold, I will punish the king of Babylon
and his land,
as I have punished the king of Assyria.
19 I will bring Israel again to his pasture,
and he will feed on Carmel and
Bashan.
His soul will be satisfied on the hills of
Ephraim and in Gilead.
20 In those days, and in that time," says
Yahweh,
"the iniquity of Israel will be sought
for,
and there will be none,
also the sins of Judah,
and they won't be found;
for I will pardon them whom I leave
as a remnant.

21 "Go up against the land of Merathaim,
even against it, and against the
inhabitants of Pekod.
Kill and utterly destroy after them," says
Yahweh,
"and do according to all that I have
commanded you.
22 A sound of battle is in the land,
and of great destruction.
23 How the hammer of the whole earth is
cut apart and broken!
How Babylon has become a
desolation among the nations!
24 I have laid a snare for you,
and you are also taken, Babylon,
and you weren't aware.
You are found,
and also caught,
because you have fought against
Yahweh.
25 Yahweh has opened his armory,
and has brought out the weapons of
his indignation;
for the Lord, Yahweh of Armies, has a
work to do in the land of the
Chaldeans.
26 Come against her from the farthest
border.
Open her storehouses.
Cast her up as heaps.
Destroy her utterly.
Let nothing of her be left.
27 Kill all her bulls.
Let them go down to the slaughter.
Woe to them! For their day has come,
the time of their visitation.
28 Listen to those who flee and escape out
of the land of Babylon,
to declare in Zion the vengeance of
Yahweh our God,
the vengeance of his temple.

29 "Call together the archers against
Babylon,
all those who bend the bow.

Encamp against her all around.
Let none of it escape.
Pay her back according to her work.
According to all that she has done, do to her;
for she has been proud against Yahweh,
against the Holy One of Israel.
30 Therefore her young men will fall in her streets.
All her men of war will be brought to silence in that day," says Yahweh.
31 "Behold, I am against you, you proud one," says the Lord, Yahweh of Armies;
"for your day has come,
the time that I will visit you.
32 The proud one will stumble and fall,
and no one will raise him up.
I will kindle a fire in his cities,
and it will devour all who are around him."
33 Yahweh of Armies says: "The children of Israel and the children of Judah are oppressed together.
All who took them captive hold them fast.
They refuse to let them go.
34 Their Redeemer is strong.
Yahweh of Armies is his name.
He will thoroughly plead their cause,
that he may give rest to the earth,
and disquiet the inhabitants of Babylon.

35 "A sword is on the Chaldeans," says Yahweh,
"and on the inhabitants of Babylon,
on her princes,
and on her wise men.
36 A sword is on the boasters,
and they will become fools.
A sword is on her mighty men,
and they will be dismayed.
37 A sword is on their horses,
on their chariots,
and on all the mixed people who are in the middle of her;
and they will become as women.
A sword is on her treasures,
and they will be robbed.
38 A drought is on her waters,
and they will be dried up;
for it is a land of engraved images,
and they are mad over idols.
39 Therefore the wild animals of the desert with the wolves will dwell there.
The ostriches will dwell therein.
It will be inhabited no more forever,
neither will it be lived in from generation to generation.
40 As when God overthrew Sodom and Gomorrah and its neighbor cities," says Yahweh,
"so no man will dwell there,
neither will any son of man live therein.

41 "Behold, a people comes from the north.
A great nation and many kings will be stirred up from the uttermost parts of the earth.
42 They take up bow and spear.
They are cruel, and have no mercy.
Their voice roars like the sea.
They ride on horses,
everyone set in array,
as a man to the battle,
against you, daughter of Babylon.
43 The king of Babylon has heard the news of them,
and his hands become feeble.
Anguish has taken hold of him,
pains as of a woman in labor.
44 Behold, the enemy will come up like a lion
from the thickets of the Jordan against the strong habitation;
for I will suddenly make them run away from it.
Whoever is chosen,
I will appoint him over it,
for who is like me?
Who will appoint me a time?
Who is the shepherd who can stand before me?"
45 Therefore hear the counsel of Yahweh that he has taken against Babylon;
and his purposes
that he has purposed against the land of the Chaldeans:
Surely they will drag them away,
even the little ones of the flock.
Surely he will make their habitation desolate over them.
46 The earth trembles at the noise of the taking of Babylon.

The cry is heard among the nations.

51

1 Yahweh says:
"Behold, I will raise up against Babylon,
and against those who dwell in
Lebkamai, a destroying wind.
2 I will send to Babylon strangers, who will
winnow her.
They will empty her land;
for in the day of trouble they will be
against her all around.
3 Against him who bends, let the archer
bend his bow,
also against him who lifts himself up
in his coat of mail.
Don't spare her young men!
Utterly destroy all her army!
4 They will fall down slain in the land of
the Chaldeans,
and thrust through in her streets.
5 For Israel is not forsaken, nor Judah, by
his God,
by Yahweh of Armies;
though their land is full of guilt
against the Holy One of Israel.

6 "Flee out of the middle of Babylon!
Everyone save his own life!
Don't be cut off in her iniquity,
for it is the time of Yahweh's
vengeance.
He will give to her a recompense.
7 Babylon has been a golden cup in
Yahweh's hand,
who made all the earth drunk.
The nations have drunk of her wine;
therefore the nations have gone mad.
8 Babylon has suddenly fallen and been
destroyed!
Wail for her!
Take balm for her pain.
Perhaps she may be healed.

9 "We would have healed Babylon,
but she is not healed.
Forsake her,
and let's each go into his own country;
for her judgment reaches to heaven,
and is lifted up even to the skies.
10 'Yahweh has produced our
righteousness.
Come, and let's declare in Zion the
work of Yahweh our God.'

11 "Make the arrows sharp!
Hold the shields firmly!
Yahweh has stirred up the spirit of the
kings of the Medes,
because his purpose is against
Babylon, to destroy it;
for it is the vengeance of Yahweh,
the vengeance of his temple.
12 Set up a standard against the walls of
Babylon!
Make the watch strong!
Set the watchmen,
and prepare the ambushes;
for Yahweh has both purposed and done
that which he spoke concerning the
inhabitants of Babylon.
13 You who dwell on many waters,
abundant in treasures,
your end has come, the measure of
your covetousness.
14 Yahweh of Armies has sworn by
himself, saying,
'Surely I will fill you with men,
as with locusts,
and they will lift up a shout against
you.'

15 "He has made the earth by his power.
He has established the world by his
wisdom.
By his understanding he has
stretched out the heavens.
16 When he utters his voice,
there is a roar of waters in the
heavens,
and he causes the vapors to ascend
from the ends of the earth.
He makes lightning for the rain,
and brings the wind out of his
treasuries.

17 "Every man has become stupid and
without knowledge.
Every goldsmith is disappointed by
his image,
for his molten images are falsehood,
and there is no breath in them.
18 They are vanity,
a work of delusion.

In the time of their visitation, they
will perish.
19 The portion of Jacob is not like these,
for he formed all things,
including the tribe of his inheritance.
Yahweh of Armies is his name.

20 “You are my battle ax and weapons of
war.
With you I will break the nations into
pieces.
With you I will destroy kingdoms.
21 With you I will break in pieces
the horse and his rider.
22 With you I will break in pieces
the chariot and him who rides
therein.
With you I will break in pieces
man and woman.
With you I will break in pieces
the old man and the youth.
With you I will break in pieces
the young man and the virgin.
23 With you I will break in pieces
the shepherd and his flock.
With you I will break in pieces
the farmer and his yoke.
With you I will break in pieces
governors and deputies.
24 “I will give to Babylon and to all the
inhabitants of Chaldea all their evil that
they have done in Zion in your sight,” says
Yahweh.
25 “Behold, I am against you, destroying
mountain,” says Yahweh,
“which destroys all the earth.
I will stretch out my hand on you,
roll you down from the rocks,
and will make you a burned
mountain.
26 They won’t take a cornerstone from
you,
nor a stone for foundations;
but you will be desolate forever,” says
Yahweh.

27 “Set up a standard in the land!
Blow the trumpet among the nations!
Prepare the nations against her!
Call together against her the
kingdoms of Ararat, Minni, and
Ashkenaz!
Appoint a marshal against her!
Cause the horses to come up as the
swarming locusts!
28 Prepare against her the nations,
the kings of the Medes, its governors,
and all its deputies, and all the land
of their dominion!
29 The land trembles and is in pain;
for the purposes of Yahweh against
Babylon stand,
to make the land of Babylon a
desolation, without inhabitant.
30 The mighty men of Babylon have
stopped fighting,
they remain in their strongholds.
Their might has failed.
They have become as women.
Her dwelling places are set on fire.
Her bars are broken.
31 One runner will run to meet another,
and one messenger to meet another,
to show the king of Babylon that his
city is taken on every quarter.
32 So the passages are seized.
They have burned the reeds with fire.
The men of war are frightened.”
33 For Yahweh of Armies, the God of
Israel says:
“The daughter of Babylon is like a
threshing floor at the time when it
is trodden.
Yet a little while, and the time of
harvest comes for her.”

34 “Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon
has devoured me.
He has crushed me.
He has made me an empty vessel.
He has, like a monster, swallowed me up.
He has filled his mouth with my
delicacies.
He has cast me out.
35 May the violence done to me and to my
flesh be on Babylon!”
the inhabitant of Zion will say; and,
“May my blood be on the inhabitants of
Chaldea!”
will Jerusalem say.

36 Therefore Yahweh says:
“Behold, I will plead your cause,
and take vengeance for you.
I will dry up her sea,

and make her fountain dry.
37 Babylon will become heaps,
a dwelling place for jackals,
an astonishment, and a hissing,
without inhabitant.
38 They will roar together like young lions.
They will growl as lions' cubs.
39 When they are inflamed, I will make
their feast,
and I will make them drunk,
that they may rejoice,
and sleep a perpetual sleep,
and not wake up," says Yahweh.

40 "I will bring them down like lambs to
the slaughter,
like rams with male goats.

41 "How Sheshach is taken!
How the praise of the whole earth is
seized!
How Babylon has become a
desolation among the nations!
42 The sea has come up on Babylon.
She is covered with the multitude of
its waves.
43 Her cities have become a desolation,
a dry land, and a desert,
a land in which no man dwells.
No son of man passes by it.
44 I will execute judgment on Bel in
Babylon,
and I will bring out of his mouth that
which he has swallowed up.
The nations will not flow any more to him.
Yes, the wall of Babylon will fall.

45 "My people, go away from the middle of
her,
and each of you save yourselves from
Yahweh's fierce anger.
46 Don't let your heart faint.
Don't fear for the news that will be
heard in the land.
For news will come one year,
and after that in another year news
will come,
and violence in the land,
ruler against ruler.
47 Therefore behold, the days come that I
will execute judgment on the
engraved images of Babylon;
and her whole land will be
confounded.
All her slain will fall in the middle of
her.
48 Then the heavens and the earth,
and all that is therein,
will sing for joy over Babylon;
for the destroyers will come to her
from the north," says Yahweh.

49 "As Babylon has caused the slain of
Israel to fall,
so the slain of all the land will fall at
Babylon.
50 You who have escaped the sword, go!
Don't stand still!
Remember Yahweh from afar,
and let Jerusalem come into your
mind."

51 "We are confounded
because we have heard reproach.
Confusion has covered our faces,
for strangers have come into the
sanctuaries of Yahweh's house."

52 "Therefore behold, the days come," says
Yahweh,
"that I will execute judgment on her
engraved images;
and through all her land the
wounded will groan.
53 Though Babylon should mount up to the
sky,
and though she should fortify the
height of her strength,
yet destroyers will come to her from
me," says Yahweh.

54 "The sound of a cry comes from
Babylon,
and of great destruction from the
land of the Chaldeans!
55 For Yahweh lays Babylon waste,
and destroys out of her the great
voice!
Their waves roar like many waters.
The noise of their voice is uttered.
56 For the destroyer has come on her,
even on Babylon.
Her mighty men are taken.
Their bows are broken in pieces,
for Yahweh is a God of retribution.
He will surely repay.

57 I will make her princes, her wise men,
her governors, her deputies, and her
mighty men drunk.
They will sleep a perpetual sleep,
and not wake up,"
says the King, whose name is Yahweh
of Armies.
58 Yahweh of Armies says:
"The wide walls of Babylon will be utterly
overthrown.
Her high gates will be burned with
fire.
The peoples will labor for vanity,
and the nations for the fire;
and they will be weary."
59 The word which Jeremiah the prophet commanded Seraiah the son of Neriah, the son of Mahseiah, when he went with Zedekiah the king of Judah to Babylon in the fourth year of his reign. Now Seraiah was chief quartermaster.
60 Jeremiah wrote in a book all the evil that should come on Babylon, even all these words that are written concerning Babylon.
61 Jeremiah said to Seraiah, "When you come to Babylon, then see that you read all these words,
62 and say, 'Yahweh, you have spoken concerning this place, to cut it off, that no one will dwell in it, neither man nor animal, but that it will be desolate forever.'
63 It will be, when you have finished reading this book, that you shall bind a stone to it, and cast it into the middle of the Euphrates.
64 Then you shall say, 'Thus will Babylon sink, and will not rise again because of the evil that I will bring on her; and they will be weary.' "

Thus far are the words of Jeremiah.

52

1 Zedekiah was twenty-one years old when he began to reign. He reigned eleven years in Jerusalem. His mother's name was Hamutal the daughter of Jeremiah of Libnah.
2 He did that which was evil in Yahweh's sight, according to all that Jehoiakim had done.
3 For through Yahweh's anger this happened in Jerusalem and Judah, until he had cast them out from his presence.

Zedekiah rebelled against the king of Babylon.

4 In the ninth year of his reign, in the tenth month, in the tenth day of the month, Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon came, he and all his army, against Jerusalem, and encamped against it; and they built forts against it round about.
5 So the city was besieged to the eleventh year of King Zedekiah.
6 In the fourth month, in the ninth day of the month, the famine was severe in the city, so that there was no bread for the people of the land.
7 Then a breach was made in the city, and all the men of war fled, and went out of the city by night by the way of the gate between the two walls, which was by the king's garden. Now the Chaldeans were against the city all around. The men of war went toward the Arabah,
8 but the army of the Chaldeans pursued the king, and overtook Zedekiah in the plains of Jericho; and all his army was scattered from him.
9 Then they took the king, and carried him up to the king of Babylon to Riblah in the land of Hamath; and he pronounced judgment on him.
10 The king of Babylon killed the sons of Zedekiah before his eyes. He also killed all the princes of Judah in Riblah.
11 He put out the eyes of Zedekiah; and the king of Babylon bound him in fetters, and carried him to Babylon, and put him in prison until the day of his death.
12 Now in the fifth month, in the tenth day of the month, which was the nineteenth year of King Nebuchadnezzar, king of Babylon, Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard, who stood before the king of Babylon, came into Jerusalem.
13 He burned Yahweh's house, and the king's house; and all the houses of Jerusalem, even every great house, he burned with fire.
14 All the army of the Chaldeans, who were with the captain of the guard, broke

down all the walls of Jerusalem all around.
15 Then Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard carried away captive of the poorest of the people, and the rest of the people who were left in the city, and those who fell away, who defected to the king of Babylon, and the rest of the multitude.
16 But Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard left of the poorest of the land to be vineyard keepers and farmers.
17 The Chaldeans broke the pillars of bronze that were in Yahweh's house and the bases and the bronze sea that were in Yahweh's house in pieces, and carried all of their bronze to Babylon.
18 They also took away the pots, the shovels, the snuffers, the basins, the spoons, and all the vessels of bronze with which they ministered.
19 The captain of the guard took away the cups, the fire pans, the basins, the pots, the lamp stands, the spoons, and the bowls; that which was of gold, as gold, and that which was of silver, as silver.
20 They took the two pillars, the one sea, and the twelve bronze bulls that were under the bases, which King Solomon had made for Yahweh's house. The bronze of all these vessels was without weight.
21 As for the pillars, the height of the one pillar was eighteen cubits;† and a line of twelve cubits encircled it; and its thickness was four fingers. It was hollow.
22 A capital of bronze was on it; and the height of the one capital was five cubits,‡ with network and pomegranates on the capital all around, all of bronze. The second pillar also had the same, with pomegranates.
23 There were ninety-six pomegranates on the sides; all the pomegranates were one hundred on the network all around.
24 The captain of the guard took Seraiah the chief priest, and Zephaniah the second priest, and the three keepers of the threshold,
25 and out of the city he took an officer who was set over the men of war; and seven men of those who saw the king's face, who were found in the city; and the scribe of the captain of the army, who mustered the people of the land; and sixty men of the people of the land, who were found in the middle of the city.
26 Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard took them, and brought them to the king of Babylon to Riblah.
27 The king of Babylon struck them, and put them to death at Riblah in the land of Hamath.
So Judah was carried away captive out of his land.
28 This is the number of the people whom Nebuchadnezzar carried away captive:
in the seventh year, three thousand twenty-three Jews;
29 in the eighteenth year of Nebuchadnezzar, he carried away captive from Jerusalem eight hundred thirty-two persons;
30 in the twenty-third year of Nebuchadnezzar, Nebuzaradan the captain of the guard carried away captive of the Jews seven hundred forty-five people.
All the people numbered four thousand six hundred.
31 In the thirty-seventh year of the captivity of Jehoiachin king of Judah, in the twelfth month, in the twenty-fifth day of the month, Evilmerodach king of Babylon, in the first year of his reign, lifted up the head of Jehoiachin king of Judah, and released him from prison.
32 He spoke kindly to him, and set his throne above the throne of the kings who were with him in Babylon,
33 and changed his prison garments.
Jehoiachin ate bread before him continually all the days of his life.
34 For his allowance, there was a continual allowance given him by the king of Babylon, every day a portion until the day of his death, all the days of his life.

† **52:21** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. ‡ **52:22** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

The Lamentations of Jeremiah

1 How the city sits solitary,
that was full of people!
She has become as a widow,
who was great among the nations!
She who was a princess among the provinces
has become a slave!

2 She weeps bitterly in the night.
Her tears are on her cheeks.
Among all her lovers
she has no one to comfort her.
All her friends have dealt treacherously with her.
They have become her enemies.

3 Judah has gone into captivity because of affliction
and because of great servitude.
She dwells among the nations.
She finds no rest.
All her persecutors overtook her in her distress.

4 The roads to Zion mourn,
because no one comes to the solemn assembly.
All her gates are desolate.
Her priests sigh.
Her virgins are afflicted,
and she herself is in bitterness.

5 Her adversaries have become the head.
Her enemies prosper;
for Yahweh† has afflicted her for the multitude of her transgressions.
Her young children have gone into captivity before the adversary.

6 All majesty has departed from the daughter of Zion.
Her princes have become like deer that find no pasture.
They have gone without strength before the pursuer.

7 Jerusalem remembers in the days of her affliction and of her miseries
all her pleasant things that were from the days of old;
when her people fell into the hand of the adversary,
and no one helped her.
The adversaries saw her.
They mocked at her desolations.

8 Jerusalem has grievously sinned.
Therefore she has become unclean.
All who honored her despise her,
because they have seen her nakedness.
Yes, she sighs and turns backward.

9 Her filthiness was in her skirts.
She didn't remember her latter end.
Therefore she has come down astoundingly.
She has no comforter.
"See, Yahweh, my affliction;
for the enemy has magnified himself."

10 The adversary has spread out his hand on all her pleasant things;
for she has seen that the nations have entered into her sanctuary,
concerning whom you commanded that they should not enter into your assembly.

11 All her people sigh.
They seek bread.
They have given their pleasant things for food to refresh their soul.
"Look, Yahweh, and see,
for I have become despised."

12 "Is it nothing to you, all you who pass by?
Look, and see if there is any sorrow like my sorrow,
which is brought on me,
with which Yahweh has afflicted me in the day of his fierce anger.

13 "From on high has he sent fire into my bones,
and it prevails against them.
He has spread a net for my feet.

† **1:5** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations.

He has turned me back.
He has made me desolate and I faint
all day long.

14 "The yoke of my transgressions is
bound by his hand.
They are knit together.
They have come up on my neck.
He made my strength fail.
The Lord‡ has delivered me into their
hands,
against whom I am not able to stand.

15 "The Lord has set at nothing all my
mighty men within me.
He has called a solemn assembly
against me to crush my young men.
The Lord has trodden the virgin
daughter of Judah as in a wine
press.

16 "For these things I weep.
My eye, my eye runs down with
water,
because the comforter who should
refresh my soul is far from me.
My children are desolate,
because the enemy has prevailed."

17 Zion spreads out her hands.
There is no one to comfort her.
Yahweh has commanded concerning
Jacob,
that those who are around him
should be his adversaries.
Jerusalem is among them as an
unclean thing.

18 "Yahweh is righteous,
for I have rebelled against his
commandment.
Please hear all you peoples,
and see my sorrow.
My virgins and my young men have
gone into captivity.

19 "I called for my lovers,
but they deceived me.
My priests and my elders gave up the
spirit in the city,
while they sought food for themselves
to refresh their souls.

20 "Look, Yahweh; for I am in distress.
My heart is troubled.
My heart turns over within me,
for I have grievously rebelled.
Abroad, the sword bereaves.
At home, it is like death.

21 "They have heard that I sigh.
There is no one to comfort me.
All my enemies have heard of my trouble.
They are glad that you have done it.
You will bring the day that you have
proclaimed,
and they will be like me.

22 "Let all their wickedness come before
you.
Do to them as you have done to me
for all my transgressions.
For my sighs are many,
and my heart is faint.

2

1 How has the Lord covered the
daughter of Zion with a cloud in his anger!
He has cast the beauty of Israel down
from heaven to the earth,
and hasn't remembered his footstool
in the day of his anger.

2 The Lord has swallowed up all the
dwellings of Jacob
without pity.
He has thrown down in his wrath the
strongholds of the daughter of
Judah.
He has brought them down to the
ground.
He has profaned the kingdom and its
princes.

3 He has cut off all the horn of Israel in
fierce anger.
He has drawn back his right hand
from before the enemy.
He has burned up Jacob like a flaming fire,
which devours all around.

4 He has bent his bow like an enemy.
He has stood with his right hand as an
adversary.

‡ **1:14** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai."

He has killed all that were pleasant to the eye.
In the tent of the daughter of Zion, he has poured out his wrath like fire.

5 The Lord has become as an enemy.
He has swallowed up Israel.
He has swallowed up all her palaces.
He has destroyed his strongholds.
He has multiplied mourning and lamentation in the daughter of Judah.

6 He has violently taken away his tabernacle,
as if it were a garden.
He has destroyed his place of assembly.
Yahweh has caused solemn assembly and Sabbath to be forgotten in Zion.
In the indignation of his anger, he has despised the king and the priest.

7 The Lord has cast off his altar.
He has abhorred his sanctuary.
He has given the walls of her palaces into the hand of the enemy.
They have made a noise in Yahweh's house,
as in the day of a solemn assembly.

8 Yahweh has purposed to destroy the wall of the daughter of Zion.
He has stretched out the line.
He has not withdrawn his hand from destroying;
He has made the rampart and wall lament.
They languish together.

9 Her gates have sunk into the ground.
He has destroyed and broken her bars.
Her king and her princes are among the nations where the law is not.
Yes, her prophets find no vision from Yahweh.

10 The elders of the daughter of Zion sit on the ground.
They keep silence.
They have cast up dust on their heads.
They have clothed themselves with sackcloth.
The virgins of Jerusalem hang down their heads to the ground.

11 My eyes fail with tears.
My heart is troubled.
My bile is poured on the earth,
because of the destruction of the daughter of my people,
because the young children and the infants swoon in the streets of the city.

12 They ask their mothers,
"Where is grain and wine?"
when they swoon as the wounded in the streets of the city,
when their soul is poured out into their mothers' bosom.

13 What shall I testify to you?
What shall I liken to you, daughter of Jerusalem?
What shall I compare to you,
that I may comfort you, virgin daughter of Zion?
For your breach is as big as the sea.
Who can heal you?

14 Your prophets have seen false and foolish visions for you.
They have not uncovered your iniquity,
to reverse your captivity,
but have seen for you false revelations and causes of banishment.

15 All that pass by clap their hands at you.
They hiss and wag their head at the daughter of Jerusalem, saying,
"Is this the city that men called 'The perfection of beauty,
the joy of the whole earth'?"

16 All your enemies have opened their mouth wide against you.
They hiss and gnash their teeth.
They say, "We have swallowed her up.
Certainly this is the day that we looked for.
We have found it.
We have seen it."

17 Yahweh has done that which he planned.
He has fulfilled his word that he commanded in the days of old.
He has thrown down,
and has not pitied.
He has caused the enemy to rejoice over you.
He has exalted the horn of your adversaries.

18 Their heart cried to the Lord.
O wall of the daughter of Zion,
let tears run down like a river day and night.
Give yourself no relief.
Don't let your eyes rest.

19 Arise, cry out in the night,
at the beginning of the watches!
Pour out your heart like water before the face of the Lord.
Lift up your hands toward him for the life of your young children,
who faint for hunger at the head of every street.

20 "Look, Yahweh, and see to whom you have done thus!
Should the women eat their offspring,
the children that they held and bounced on their knees?
Should the priest and the prophet be killed in the sanctuary of the Lord?

21 "The youth and the old man lie on the ground in the streets.
My virgins and my young men have fallen by the sword.
You have killed them in the day of your anger.
You have slaughtered, and not pitied.

22 "You have called, as in the day of a solemn assembly, my terrors on every side.
There was no one that escaped or remained in the day of Yahweh's anger.
My enemy has consumed those whom I have cared for and brought up.

3

1 I am the man who has seen affliction
by the rod of his wrath.
2 He has led me and caused me to walk in darkness,
and not in light.
3 Surely he turns his hand against me
again and again all day long.

4 He has made my flesh and my skin old.
He has broken my bones.
5 He has built against me,
and surrounded me with bitterness and hardship.
6 He has made me dwell in dark places,
as those who have been long dead.

7 He has walled me about, so that I can't go out.
He has made my chain heavy.
8 Yes, when I cry, and call for help,
he shuts out my prayer.
9 He has walled up my ways with cut stone.
He has made my paths crooked.

10 He is to me as a bear lying in wait,
as a lion in hiding.
11 He has turned away my path,
and pulled me in pieces.
He has made me desolate.
12 He has bent his bow,
and set me as a mark for the arrow.

13 He has caused the shafts of his quiver to enter into my kidneys.
14 I have become a derision to all my people,
and their song all day long.
15 He has filled me with bitterness.
He has stuffed me with wormwood.

16 He has also broken my teeth with gravel.
He has covered me with ashes.
17 You have removed my soul far away from peace.
I forgot prosperity.
18 I said, "My strength has perished,
along with my expectation from Yahweh."

19 Remember my affliction and my misery,

the wormwood and the bitterness.
20 My soul still remembers them,
and is bowed down within me.
21 This I recall to my mind;
therefore I have hope.

22 It is because of Yahweh's loving
kindnesses that we are not
consumed,
because his mercies don't fail.
23 They are new every morning.
Great is your faithfulness.
24 "Yahweh is my portion," says my soul.
"Therefore I will hope in him."

25 Yahweh is good to those who wait for
him,
to the soul who seeks him.
26 It is good that a man should hope
and quietly wait for the salvation of
Yahweh.
27 It is good for a man that he bear the
yoke in his youth.

28 Let him sit alone and keep silence,
because he has laid it on him.
29 Let him put his mouth in the dust,
if it is so that there may be hope.
30 Let him give his cheek to him who
strikes him.
Let him be filled full of reproach.

31 For the Lord will not cast off forever.
32 For though he causes grief,
yet he will have compassion
according to the multitude of his
loving kindnesses.
33 For he does not afflict willingly,
nor grieve the children of men.

34 To crush under foot all the prisoners of
the earth,
35 to turn away the right of a man
before the face of the Most High,
36 to subvert a man in his cause, the
Lord doesn't approve.

37 Who is he who says, and it comes to
pass,
when the Lord doesn't command it?
38 Doesn't evil and good come out of the
mouth of the Most High?
39 Why should a living man complain,
a man for the punishment of his sins?

40 Let us search and try our ways,
and turn again to Yahweh.
41 Let's lift up our heart with our hands to
God† in the heavens.
42 "We have transgressed and have
rebelled.
You have not pardoned.

43 "You have covered us with anger and
pursued us.
You have killed.
You have not pitied.
44 You have covered yourself with a cloud,
so that no prayer can pass through.
45 You have made us an off-scouring and
refuse
in the middle of the peoples.

46 "All our enemies have opened their
mouth wide against us.
47 Terror and the pit have come on us,
devastation and destruction."

48 My eye runs down with streams of
water,
for the destruction of the daughter of
my people.
49 My eye pours down
and doesn't cease,
without any intermission,
50 until Yahweh looks down,
and sees from heaven.
51 My eye affects my soul,
because of all the daughters of my
city.

52 They have chased me relentlessly like a
bird,
those who are my enemies without
cause.
53 They have cut off my life in the
dungeon,
and have cast a stone on me.
54 Waters flowed over my head.
I said, "I am cut off."

55 I called on your name, Yahweh,
out of the lowest dungeon.
56 You heard my voice:

† **3:41** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

“Don’t hide your ear from my sighing,
and my cry.”

57 You came near in the day that I called on you.
You said, “Don’t be afraid.”

58 Lord, you have pleaded the causes of my soul.
You have redeemed my life.
59 Yahweh, you have seen my wrong.
Judge my cause.
60 You have seen all their vengeance
and all their plans against me.

61 You have heard their reproach, Yahweh,
and all their plans against me,
62 the lips of those that rose up against me,
and their plots against me all day long.
63 You see their sitting down and their rising up.
I am their song.

64 You will pay them back, Yahweh,
according to the work of their hands.
65 You will give them hardness of heart,
your curse to them.
66 You will pursue them in anger,
and destroy them from under the heavens of Yahweh.

4

1 How the gold has become dim!
The most pure gold has changed!
The stones of the sanctuary are poured out
at the head of every street.

2 The precious sons of Zion,
comparable to fine gold,
how they are esteemed as earthen pitchers,
the work of the hands of the potter!

3 Even the jackals offer their breast.
They nurse their young ones.
But the daughter of my people has become cruel,
like the ostriches in the wilderness.

4 The tongue of the nursing child clings to the roof of his mouth for thirst.
The young children ask for bread,
and no one breaks it for them.

5 Those who ate delicacies are desolate in the streets.
Those who were brought up in purple embrace dunghills.

6 For the iniquity of the daughter of my people is greater than the sin of Sodom,
which was overthrown as in a moment.
No hands were laid on her.

7 Her nobles were purer than snow.
They were whiter than milk.
They were more ruddy in body than rubies.
Their polishing was like sapphire.

8 Their appearance is blacker than a coal.
They are not known in the streets.
Their skin clings to their bones.
It is withered.
It has become like wood.

9 Those who are killed with the sword are better than those who are killed with hunger;
for these pine away, stricken through,
for lack of the fruits of the field.

10 The hands of the pitiful women have boiled their own children.
They were their food in the destruction of the daughter of my people.

11 Yahweh has accomplished his wrath.
He has poured out his fierce anger.
He has kindled a fire in Zion,
which has devoured its foundations.

12 The kings of the earth didn’t believe,
neither did all the inhabitants of the world,
that the adversary and the enemy would enter into the gates of Jerusalem.

13 It is because of the sins of her prophets
and the iniquities of her priests,

that have shed the blood of the just in
the middle of her.

14 They wander as blind men in the
streets.
They are polluted with blood,
So that men can't touch their
garments.

15 "Go away!" they cried to them.
"Unclean! Go away! Go away! Don't
touch!
When they fled away and wandered, men
said among the nations,
"They can't live here any more."

16 Yahweh's anger has scattered them.
He will not pay attention to them any
more.
They didn't respect the persons of the
priests.
They didn't favor the elders.

17 Our eyes still fail,
looking in vain for our help.
In our watching we have watched for
a nation that could not save.

18 They hunt our steps,
so that we can't go in our streets.
Our end is near.
Our days are fulfilled,
for our end has come.

19 Our pursuers were swifter than the
eagles of the sky.
They chased us on the mountains.
They set an ambush for us in the
wilderness.

20 The breath of our nostrils,
the anointed of Yahweh,
was taken in their pits;
of whom we said,
under his shadow we will live among
the nations.

21 Rejoice and be glad, daughter of Edom,
who dwells in the land of Uz.
The cup will pass through to you also.
You will be drunken,
and will make yourself naked.

22 The punishment of your iniquity is
accomplished, daughter of Zion.
He will no more carry you away into
captivity.
He will visit your iniquity, daughter of
Edom.
He will uncover your sins.

5

1 Remember, Yahweh, what has come on
us.
Look, and see our reproach.
2 Our inheritance has been turned over to
strangers,
our houses to aliens.
3 We are orphans and fatherless.
Our mothers are as widows.
4 We must pay for water to drink.
Our wood is sold to us.
5 Our pursuers are on our necks.
We are weary, and have no rest.
6 We have given our hands to the
Egyptians,
and to the Assyrians, to be satisfied
with bread.
7 Our fathers sinned, and are no more.
We have borne their iniquities.
8 Servants rule over us.
There is no one to deliver us out of
their hand.
9 We get our bread at the peril of our lives,
because of the sword in the
wilderness.
10 Our skin is black like an oven,
because of the burning heat of
famine.
11 They ravished the women in Zion,
the virgins in the cities of Judah.
12 Princes were hanged up by their hands.
The faces of elders were not honored.
13 The young men carry millstones.
The children stumbled under loads of
wood.
14 The elders have ceased from the gate,
and the young men from their music.
15 The joy of our heart has ceased.
Our dance is turned into mourning.
16 The crown has fallen from our head.
Woe to us, for we have sinned!
17 For this our heart is faint.
For these things our eyes are dim:
18 for the mountain of Zion, which is
desolate.
The foxes walk on it.

19 You, Yahweh, remain forever.
Your throne is from generation to generation.
20 Why do you forget us forever,
and forsake us for so long a time?
21 Turn us to yourself, Yahweh, and we will be turned.
Renew our days as of old.
22 But you have utterly rejected us.
You are very angry against us.

The Book of Ezekiel

1 Now in the thirtieth year, in the fourth
month, in the fifth day of the month, as I
was among the captives by the river
Chebar, the heavens were opened, and I
saw visions of God.†
2 In the fifth of the month, which was
the fifth year of King Jehoiachin's
captivity,
3 Yahweh's‡ word came to Ezekiel the
priest, the son of Buzi, in the land of the
Chaldeans by the river Chebar; and
Yahweh's hand was there on him.
4 I looked, and behold,§ a stormy wind
came out of the north: a great cloud, with
flashing lightning, and a brightness
around it, and out of the middle of it as it
were glowing metal, out of the middle of
the fire.
5 Out of its center came the likeness of
four living creatures. This was their
appearance: They had the likeness of a
man.
6 Everyone had four faces, and each one
of them had four wings.
7 Their feet were straight feet. The sole
of their feet was like the sole of a calf's
foot; and they sparkled like burnished
bronze.
8 They had the hands of a man under
their wings on their four sides. The four of
them had their faces and their wings like
this:
9 Their wings were joined to one
another. They didn't turn when they
went. Each one went straight forward.
10 As for the likeness of their faces, they
had the face of a man. The four of them
had the face of a lion on the right side. The
four of them had the face of an ox on the
left side. The four of them also had the
face of an eagle.
11 Such were their faces. Their wings
were spread out above. Two wings of
each one touched another, and two
covered their bodies.
12 Each one went straight forward.
Where the spirit was to go, they went.
They didn't turn when they went.
13 As for the likeness of the living
creatures, their appearance was like
burning coals of fire, like the appearance
of torches. The fire went up and down
among the living creatures. The fire was
bright, and lightning went out of the fire.
14 The living creatures ran and returned
as the appearance of a flash of lightning.
15 Now as I saw the living creatures,
behold, there was one wheel on the earth
beside the living creatures, for each of the
four faces of it.
16 The appearance of the wheels and
their work was like a beryl. The four of
them had one likeness. Their appearance
and their work was as it were a wheel
within a wheel.
17 When they went, they went in their
four directions. They didn't turn when
they went.
18 As for their rims, they were high and
dreadful; and the four of them had their
rims full of eyes all around.
19 When the living creatures went, the
wheels went beside them. When the
living creatures were lifted up from the
earth, the wheels were lifted up.
20 Wherever the spirit was to go, they
went. The spirit was to go there. The
wheels were lifted up beside them; for the
spirit of the living creature was in the
wheels.
21 When those went, these went. When
those stood, these stood. When those were
lifted up from the earth, the wheels were
lifted up beside them; for the spirit of the
living creature was in the wheels.
22 Over the head of the living creature
there was the likeness of an expanse, like
an awesome crystal to look at, stretched
out over their heads above.
23 Under the expanse, their wings were
straight, one toward the other. Each one
had two which covered on this side, and
each one had two which covered their
bodies on that side.

† **1:1** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). ‡ **1:3** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. § **1:4** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

24 When they went, I heard the noise of
their wings like the noise of great waters,
like the voice of the Almighty, a noise of
tumult like the noise of an army. When
they stood, they let down their wings.
25 There was a voice above the expanse
that was over their heads. When they
stood, they let down their wings.
26 Above the expanse that was over their
heads was the likeness of a throne, as the
appearance of a sapphire† stone. On the
likeness of the throne was a likeness as
the appearance of a man on it above.
27 I saw as it were glowing metal, as the
appearance of fire within it all around,
from the appearance of his waist and
upward; and from the appearance of his
waist and downward I saw as it were the
appearance of fire, and there was
brightness around him.
28 As the appearance of the rainbow
that is in the cloud in the day of rain, so
was the appearance of the brightness all
around.
This was the appearance of the likeness
of Yahweh's glory. When I saw it, I fell on
my face, and I heard a voice of one that
spoke.

2

1 He said to me, "Son of man, stand on
your feet, and I will speak with you."
2 The Spirit entered into me when he
spoke to me, and set me on my feet; and I
heard him who spoke to me.
3 He said to me, "Son of man, I send you
to the children of Israel, to a nation of
rebels who have rebelled against me.
They and their fathers have transgressed
against me even to this very day.
4 The children are impudent and
stiff-hearted. I am sending you to them,
and you shall tell them, 'This is what the
Lord† Yahweh says.'
5 They, whether they will hear, or
whether they will refuse—for they are a
rebellious house—yet they will know that
there has been a prophet among them.
6 You, son of man, don't be afraid of
them, neither be afraid of their words,
though briers and thorns are with you,
and you dwell among scorpions. Don't be
afraid of their words, nor be dismayed at
their looks, though they are a rebellious
house.
7 You shall speak my words to them,
whether they will hear or whether they
will refuse; for they are most rebellious.
8 But you, son of man, hear what I tell
you. Don't be rebellious like that
rebellious house. Open your mouth, and
eat that which I give you."
9 When I looked, behold, a hand was
stretched out to me; and behold, a scroll of
a book was in it.
10 He spread it before me. It was written
within and without; and lamentations,
mourning, and woe were written in it.

3

1 He said to me, "Son of man, eat what
you find. Eat this scroll, and go, speak to
the house of Israel."
2 So I opened my mouth, and he caused
me to eat the scroll.
3 He said to me, "Son of man, eat this
scroll that I give you and fill your belly
and your bowels with it."
Then I ate it. It was as sweet as honey in
my mouth.
4 He said to me, "Son of man, go to the
house of Israel, and speak my words to
them.
5 For you are not sent to a people of a
strange speech and of a hard language,
but to the house of Israel—
6 not to many peoples of a strange
speech and of a hard language, whose
words you can't understand. Surely, if I
sent you to them, they would listen to you.
7 But the house of Israel will not listen to
you, for they will not listen to me; for all
the house of Israel are obstinate† and
hard-hearted.
8 Behold, I have made your face hard
against their faces, and your forehead
hard against their foreheads.
9 I have made your forehead as a
diamond, harder than flint. Don't be

† **1:26** or, lapis lazuli † **2:4** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." † **3:7** Literally, have a hard forehead

afraid of them, neither be dismayed at their looks, though they are a rebellious house."
10 Moreover he said to me, "Son of man, receive in your heart and hear with your ears all my words that I speak to you.
11 Go to them of the captivity, to the children of your people, and speak to them, and tell them, 'This is what the Lord Yahweh says,' whether they will hear, or whether they will refuse."
12 Then the Spirit lifted me up, and I heard behind me the voice of a great rushing, saying, "Blessed be Yahweh's glory from his place."
13 I heard the noise of the wings of the living creatures as they touched one another, and the noise of the wheels beside them, even the noise of a great rushing.
14 So the Spirit lifted me up, and took me away; and I went in bitterness, in the heat of my spirit; and Yahweh's hand was strong on me.
15 Then I came to them of the captivity at Tel Aviv who lived by the river Chebar, and to where they lived; and I sat there overwhelmed among them seven days.
16 At the end of seven days, Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
17 "Son of man, I have made you a watchman to the house of Israel. Therefore hear the word from my mouth, and warn them from me.
18 When I tell the wicked, 'You will surely die;' and you give him no warning, nor speak to warn the wicked from his wicked way, to save his life, that wicked man will die in his iniquity; but I will require his blood at your hand.
19 Yet if you warn the wicked, and he doesn't turn from his wickedness, nor from his wicked way, he will die in his iniquity; but you have delivered your soul."
20 "Again, when a righteous man turns from his righteousness and commits iniquity, and I lay a stumbling block before him, he will die. Because you have not given him warning, he will die in his sin, and his righteous deeds which he has done will not be remembered; but I will require his blood at your hand.
21 Nevertheless if you warn the righteous man, that the righteous not sin, and he does not sin, he will surely live, because he took warning; and you have delivered your soul."
22 Yahweh's hand was there on me; and he said to me, "Arise, go out into the plain, and I will talk with you there."
23 Then I arose, and went out into the plain, and behold, Yahweh's glory stood there, like the glory which I saw by the river Chebar. Then I fell on my face.
24 Then the Spirit entered into me and set me on my feet. He spoke with me, and said to me, "Go, shut yourself inside your house.
25 But you, son of man, behold, they will put ropes on you, and will bind you with them, and you will not go out among them.
26 I will make your tongue stick to the roof of your mouth so that you will be mute and will not be able to correct them, for they are a rebellious house.
27 But when I speak with you, I will open your mouth, and you shall tell them, 'This is what the Lord Yahweh says.' He who hears, let him hear; and he who refuses, let him refuse; for they are a rebellious house."

4

1 "You also, son of man, take a tile, and lay it before yourself, and portray on it a city, even Jerusalem.
2 Lay siege against it, build forts against it, and cast up a mound against it. Also set camps against it and plant battering rams against it all around.
3 Take for yourself an iron pan and set it for a wall of iron between you and the city. Then set your face toward it. It will be besieged, and you shall lay siege against it. This shall be a sign to the house of Israel.
4 "Moreover lie on your left side, and lay the iniquity of the house of Israel on it. According to the number of the days that you shall lie on it, you shall bear their iniquity.

5 For I have appointed the years of their
iniquity to be to you a number of days,
even three hundred ninety days. So you
shall bear the iniquity of the house of
Israel.
6 "Again, when you have accomplished
these, you shall lie on your right side, and
shall bear the iniquity of the house of
Judah. I have appointed forty days, each
day for a year, to you.
7 You shall set your face toward the siege
of Jerusalem, with your arm uncovered;
and you shall prophesy against it.
8 Behold, I put ropes on you, and you
shall not turn yourself from one side to
the other, until you have accomplished
the days of your siege.
9 "Take for yourself also wheat, barley,
beans, lentils, millet, and spelt, and put
them in one vessel. Make bread of it.
According to the number of the days that
you will lie on your side, even three
hundred ninety days, you shall eat of it.
10 Your food which you shall eat shall be
by weight, twenty shekels† a day. From
time to time you shall eat it.
11 You shall drink water by measure, the
sixth part of a hin.‡ From time to time you
shall drink.
12 You shall eat it as barley cakes, and
you shall bake it in their sight with dung
that comes out of man."
13 Yahweh said, "Even thus will the
children of Israel eat their bread unclean,
among the nations where I will drive
them."
14 Then I said, "Ah Lord Yahweh!
Behold, my soul has not been polluted; for
from my youth up even until now I have
not eaten of that which dies of itself, or is
torn of animals. No abominable meat has
come into my mouth!"
15 Then he said to me, "Behold, I have
given you cow's dung for man's dung, and
you shall prepare your bread on it."
16 Moreover he said to me, "Son of man,
behold, I will break the staff of bread in
Jerusalem. They will eat bread by weight,
and with fearfulness. They will drink
water by measure, and in dismay;
17 that they may lack bread and water,
be dismayed one with another, and pine
away in their iniquity.

5

1 "You, son of man, take a sharp sword.
You shall take it as a barber's razor to
yourself, and shall cause it to pass over
your head and over your beard. Then take
balances to weigh and divide the hair.
2 A third part you shall burn in the fire
in the middle of the city, when the days of
the siege are fulfilled. You shall take a
third part, and strike with the sword
around it. A third part you shall scatter to
the wind, and I will draw out a sword
after them.
3 You shall take a small number of these
and bind them in the folds of your robe.
4 Of these again you shall take, and cast
them into the middle of the fire, and burn
them in the fire. From it a fire will come
out into all the house of Israel.
5 "The Lord Yahweh says: 'This is
Jerusalem. I have set her in the middle of
the nations, and countries are around her.
6 She has rebelled against my
ordinances in doing wickedness more
than the nations, and against my statutes
more than the countries that are around
her; for they have rejected my
ordinances, and as for my statutes, they
have not walked in them.'
7 "Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
'Because you are more turbulent than the
nations that are around you, and have not
walked in my statutes, neither have kept
my ordinances, neither have followed the
ordinances of the nations that are around
you;
8 therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
'Behold, I, even I, am against you; and I
will execute judgments among you in the
sight of the nations.
9 I will do in you that which I have not
done, and which I will not do anything
like it any more, because of all your
abominations.
10 Therefore the fathers will eat the sons
within you, and the sons will eat their
fathers. I will execute judgments on you;

† **4:10** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.
‡ **4:11** A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

and I will scatter the whole remnant of you to all the winds.
11 Therefore as I live,' says the Lord Yahweh, 'surely, because you have defiled my sanctuary with all your detestable things, and with all your abominations, therefore I will also diminish you. My eye won't spare, and I will have no pity.
12 A third part of you will die with the pestilence, and they will be consumed with famine within you. A third part will fall by the sword around you. A third part I will scatter to all the winds, and will draw out a sword after them.
13 " 'Thus my anger will be accomplished, and I will cause my wrath toward them to rest, and I will be comforted. They will know that I, Yahweh, have spoken in my zeal, when I have accomplished my wrath on them.
14 " 'Moreover I will make you a desolation and a reproach among the nations that are around you, in the sight of all that pass by.
15 So it will be a reproach and a taunt, an instruction and an astonishment, to the nations that are around you, when I execute judgments on you in anger and in wrath, and in wrathful rebukes—I, Yahweh, have spoken it—
16 when I send on them the evil arrows of famine that are for destruction, which I will send to destroy you. I will increase the famine on you and will break your staff of bread.
17 I will send on you famine and evil animals, and they will bereave you. Pestilence and blood will pass through you. I will bring the sword on you. I, Yahweh, have spoken it.' "

6

1 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
2 "Son of man, set your face toward the mountains of Israel, and prophesy to them,
3 and say, 'You mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord Yahweh! The Lord Yahweh says to the mountains and to the hills, to the watercourses and to the valleys: "Behold, I, even I, will bring a sword on you, and I will destroy your high places.
4 Your altars will become desolate, and your incense altars will be broken. I will cast down your slain men before your idols.
5 I will lay the dead bodies of the children of Israel before their idols. I will scatter your bones around your altars.
6 In all your dwelling places, the cities will be laid waste and the high places will be desolate, so that your altars may be laid waste and made desolate, and your idols may be broken and cease, and your incense altars may be cut down, and your works may be abolished.
7 The slain will fall among you, and you will know that I am Yahweh.
8 " ' "Yet I will leave a remnant, in that you will have some that escape the sword among the nations, when you are scattered through the countries.
9 Those of you that escape will remember me among the nations where they are carried captive, how I have been broken with their lewd heart, which has departed from me, and with their eyes, which play the prostitute after their idols. Then they will loathe themselves in their own sight for the evils which they have committed in all their abominations.
10 They will know that I am Yahweh. I have not said in vain that I would do this evil to them." '
11 "The Lord Yahweh says: 'Strike with your hand, and stamp with your foot, and say, "Alas!", because of all the evil abominations of the house of Israel; for they will fall by the sword, by the famine, and by the pestilence.
12 He who is far off will die of the pestilence. He who is near will fall by the sword. He who remains and is besieged will die by the famine. Thus I will accomplish my wrath on them.
13 You will know that I am Yahweh when their slain men are among their idols around their altars, on every high hill, on all the tops of the mountains, under every green tree, and under every thick oak—the places where they offered pleasant aroma to all their idols.

14 I will stretch out my hand on them
and make the land desolate and waste,
from the wilderness toward Diblah,
throughout all their habitations. Then
they will know that I am Yahweh.' "

7

1 Moreover Yahweh's word came to me,
saying,
2 "You, son of man, the Lord Yahweh
says to the land of Israel, 'An end! The end
has come on the four corners of the land.
3 Now the end is on you, and I will send
my anger on you, and will judge you
according to your ways. I will bring on
you all your abominations.
4 My eye will not spare you, neither will
I have pity; but I will bring your ways on
you, and your abominations will be
among you. Then you will know that I am
Yahweh.'
5 "The Lord Yahweh says: 'A disaster! A
unique disaster! Behold, it comes.
6 An end has come. The end has come! It
awakes against you. Behold, it comes.
7 Your doom has come to you, inhabitant
of the land! The time has come! The day is
near, a day of tumult, and not of joyful
shouting, on the mountains.
8 Now I will shortly pour out my wrath
on you, and accomplish my anger against
you, and will judge you according to your
ways. I will bring on you all your
abominations.
9 My eye won't spare, neither will I have
pity. I will punish you according to your
ways. Your abominations will be among
you. Then you will know that I, Yahweh,
strike.
10 " 'Behold, the day! Behold, it comes!
Your doom has gone out. The rod has
blossomed. Pride has budded.
11 Violence has risen up into a rod of
wickedness. None of them will remain,
nor of their multitude, nor of their wealth.
There will be nothing of value among
them.
12 The time has come! The day draws
near. Don't let the buyer rejoice, nor the
seller mourn; for wrath is on all its
multitude.
13 For the seller won't return to that
which is sold, although they are still alive;
for the vision concerns the whole
multitude of it. None will return. None
will strengthen himself in the iniquity of
his life.
14 They have blown the trumpet, and
have made all ready; but no one goes to
the battle, for my wrath is on all its
multitude.
15 " 'The sword is outside, and the
pestilence and the famine within. He who
is in the field will die by the sword. He
who is in the city will be devoured by
famine and pestilence.
16 But of those who escape, they will
escape and will be on the mountains like
doves of the valleys, all of them moaning,
everyone in his iniquity.
17 All hands will be feeble, and all knees
will be weak as water.
18 They will also clothe themselves with
sackcloth, and horror will cover them.
Shame will be on all faces, and baldness
on all their heads.
19 They will cast their silver in the
streets, and their gold will be as an
unclean thing. Their silver and their gold
won't be able to deliver them in the day of
Yahweh's wrath. They won't satisfy their
souls or fill their bellies; because it has
been the stumbling block of their iniquity.
20 As for the beauty of his ornament, he
set it in majesty; but they made the images
of their abominations and their detestable
things therein. Therefore I have made it
to them as an unclean thing.
21 I will give it into the hands of the
strangers for a prey, and to the wicked of
the earth for a plunder; and they will
profane it.
22 I will also turn my face from them,
and they will profane my secret place.
Robbers will enter into it, and profane it.
23 " 'Make chains, for the land is full of
bloody crimes, and the city is full of
violence.
24 Therefore I will bring the worst of the
nations, and they will possess their
houses. I will also make the pride of the
strong to cease. Their holy places will be
profaned.

25 Destruction comes! They will seek
peace, and there will be none.
26 Mischief will come on mischief, and
rumor will be on rumor. They will seek a
vision of the prophet; but the law will
perish from the priest, and counsel from
the elders.
27 The king will mourn, and the prince
will be clothed with desolation. The hands
of the people of the land will be troubled.
I will do to them after their way, and
according to their own judgments I will
judge them. Then they will know that I am
Yahweh.' "

8

1 In the sixth year, in the sixth month, in
the fifth day of the month, as I sat in my
house, and the elders of Judah sat before
me, the Lord Yahweh's hand fell on me
there.
2 Then I saw, and behold, a likeness as
the appearance of fire—from the
appearance of his waist and downward,
fire, and from his waist and upward, as
the appearance of brightness, as it were
glowing metal.
3 He stretched out the form of a hand,
and took me by a lock of my head; and the
Spirit lifted me up between earth and the
sky, and brought me in the visions of God
to Jerusalem, to the door of the gate of the
inner court that looks toward the north,
where there was the seat of the image of
jealousy, which provokes to jealousy.
4 Behold, the glory of the God of Israel
was there, according to the appearance
that I saw in the plain.
5 Then he said to me, "Son of man, lift up
your eyes now the way toward the north."
So I lifted up my eyes the way toward
the north, and saw, northward of the gate
of the altar this image of jealousy in the
entry.
6 He said to me, "Son of man, do you see
what they do? Even the great
abominations that the house of Israel
commit here, that I should go far off from
my sanctuary? But you will again see yet
other great abominations."
7 He brought me to the door of the court;
and when I looked, behold, a hole in the
wall.
8 Then he said to me, "Son of man, dig
now in the wall."
When I had dug in the wall, I saw a door.
9 He said to me, "Go in, and see the
wicked abominations that they do here."
10 So I went in and looked, and saw
every form of creeping things,
abominable animals, and all the idols of
the house of Israel, portrayed around on
the wall.
11 Seventy men of the elders of the
house of Israel stood before them. In the
middle of them Jaazaniah the son of
Shaphan stood, every man with his censer
in his hand; and the smell of the cloud of
incense went up.
12 Then he said to me, "Son of man, have
you seen what the elders of the house of
Israel do in the dark, every man in his
rooms of imagery? For they say, 'Yahweh
doesn't see us. Yahweh has forsaken the
land.' "
13 He said also to me, "You will again see
more of the great abominations which
they do."
14 Then he brought me to the door of the
gate of Yahweh's house which was toward
the north; and I saw the women sit there
weeping for Tammuz.
15 Then he said to me, "Have you seen
this, son of man? You will again see yet
greater abominations than these."
16 He brought me into the inner court of
Yahweh's house; and I saw at the door of
Yahweh's temple, between the porch and
the altar, there were about twenty-five
men with their backs toward Yahweh's
temple and their faces toward the east.
They were worshiping the sun toward the
east.
17 Then he said to me, "Have you seen
this, son of man? Is it a light thing to the
house of Judah that they commit the
abominations which they commit here?
For they have filled the land with
violence, and have turned again to
provoke me to anger. Behold, they put the
branch to their nose.
18 Therefore I will also deal in wrath.
My eye won't spare, neither will I have

pity. Though they cry in my ears with a loud voice, yet I will not hear them."

9

1 Then he cried in my ears with a loud voice, saying, "Cause those who are in charge of the city to draw near, each man with his destroying weapon in his hand."
2 Behold, six men came from the way of the upper gate, which lies toward the north, every man with his slaughter weapon in his hand. One man in the middle of them was clothed in linen, with a writer's inkhorn by his side. They went in, and stood beside the bronze altar.
3 The glory of the God of Israel went up from the cherub, whereupon it was, to the threshold of the house; and he called to the man clothed in linen, who had the writer's inkhorn by his side.
4 Yahweh said to him, "Go through the middle of the city, through the middle of Jerusalem, and set a mark on the foreheads of the men that sigh and that cry over all the abominations that are done within it."
5 To the others he said in my hearing, "Go through the city after him, and strike. Don't let your eye spare, neither have pity.
6 Kill utterly the old man, the young man, the virgin, little children and women; but don't come near any man on whom is the mark. Begin at my sanctuary."

Then they began at the old men who were before the house.
7 He said to them, "Defile the house, and fill the courts with the slain. Go out!"

They went out, and struck in the city.
8 While they were killing, and I was left, I fell on my face, and cried, and said, "Ah Lord Yahweh! Will you destroy all the residue of Israel in your pouring out of your wrath on Jerusalem?"
9 Then he said to me, "The iniquity of the house of Israel and Judah is exceedingly great, and the land is full of blood, and the city full of perversion; for they say, 'Yahweh has forsaken the land, and Yahweh doesn't see.'
10 As for me also, my eye won't spare, neither will I have pity, but I will bring their way on their head."
11 Behold, the man clothed in linen, who had the inkhorn by his side, reported the matter, saying, "I have done as you have commanded me."

10

1 Then I looked, and see, in the expanse that was over the head of the cherubim there appeared above them as it were a sapphire† stone, as the appearance of the likeness of a throne.
2 He spoke to the man clothed in linen, and said, "Go in between the whirling wheels, even under the cherub, and fill both your hands with coals of fire from between the cherubim, and scatter them over the city."

He went in as I watched.
3 Now the cherubim stood on the right side of the house when the man went in; and the cloud filled the inner court.
4 Yahweh's glory mounted up from the cherub, and stood over the threshold of the house; and the house was filled with the cloud, and the court was full of the brightness of Yahweh's glory.
5 The sound of the wings of the cherubim was heard even to the outer court, as the voice of God Almighty when he speaks.
6 It came to pass, when he commanded the man clothed in linen, saying, "Take fire from between the whirling wheels, from between the cherubim," that he went in and stood beside a wheel.
7 The cherub stretched out his hand from between the cherubim to the fire that was between the cherubim, and took some of it, and put it into the hands of him who was clothed in linen, who took it and went out.
8 The form of a man's hand appeared here in the cherubim under their wings.
9 I looked, and behold, there were four wheels beside the cherubim, one wheel beside one cherub, and another wheel beside another cherub. The appearance of the wheels was like a beryl stone.

† **10:1** or, lapis lazuli

10 As for their appearance, the four of
them had one likeness, like a wheel within
a wheel.
11 When they went, they went in their
four directions. They didn't turn as they
went, but to the place where the head
looked they followed it. They didn't turn
as they went.
12 Their whole body, including their
backs, their hands, their wings, and the
wheels, were full of eyes all around, even
the wheels that the four of them had.
13 As for the wheels, they were called in
my hearing, "the whirling wheels".
14 Every one of them had four faces. The
first face was the face of the cherub. The
second face was the face of a man. The
third face was the face of a lion. The
fourth was the face of an eagle.

15 The cherubim mounted up. This is the
living creature that I saw by the river
Chebar.
16 When the cherubim went, the wheels
went beside them; and when the
cherubim lifted up their wings to mount
up from the earth, the wheels also didn't
turn from beside them.
17 When they stood, these stood. When
they mounted up, these mounted up with
them; for the spirit of the living creature
was in them.

18 Yahweh's glory went out from over
the threshold of the house and stood over
the cherubim.
19 The cherubim lifted up their wings
and mounted up from the earth in my
sight when they went out, with the wheels
beside them. Then they stood at the door
of the east gate of Yahweh's house; and
the glory of the God of Israel was over
them above.

20 This is the living creature that I saw
under the God of Israel by the river
Chebar; and I knew that they were
cherubim.
21 Every one had four faces, and every
one four wings. The likeness of the hands
of a man was under their wings.
22 As for the likeness of their faces, they
were the faces which I saw by the river
Chebar, their appearances and
themselves. They each went straight
forward.

11

1 Moreover the Spirit lifted me up and
brought me to the east gate of Yahweh's
house, which looks eastward. Behold,
twenty-five men were at the door of the
gate; and I saw among them Jaazaniah the
son of Azzur, and Pelatiah the son of
Benaiah, princes of the people.
2 He said to me, "Son of man, these are
the men who devise iniquity, and who
give wicked counsel in this city;
3 who say, 'The time is not near to build
houses. This is the cauldron, and we are
the meat.'
4 Therefore prophesy against them.
Prophesy, son of man."
5 Yahweh's Spirit fell on me, and he said
to me, "Speak, 'Yahweh says: "Thus you
have said, house of Israel; for I know the
things that come into your mind.
6 You have multiplied your slain in this
city, and you have filled its streets with
the slain."
7 " 'Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
"Your slain whom you have laid in the
middle of it, they are the meat, and this is
the cauldron; but you will be brought out
of the middle of it.
8 You have feared the sword; and I will
bring the sword on you," says the Lord
Yahweh.
9 "I will bring you out of the middle of it,
and deliver you into the hands of
strangers, and will execute judgments
among you.
10 You will fall by the sword. I will judge
you in the border of Israel. Then you will
know that I am Yahweh.
11 This will not be your cauldron,
neither will you be the meat in the middle
of it. I will judge you in the border of
Israel.
12 You will know that I am Yahweh, for
you have not walked in my statutes. You
have not executed my ordinances, but
have done after the ordinances of the
nations that are around you." ' "
13 When I prophesied, Pelatiah the son
of Benaiah died. Then I fell down on my
face, and cried with a loud voice, and said,

“Ah Lord Yahweh! Will you make a full
end of the remnant of Israel?”
14 Yahweh’s word came to me, saying,
15 “Son of man, your brothers, even
your brothers, the men of your relatives,
and all the house of Israel, all of them, are
the ones to whom the inhabitants of
Jerusalem have said, ‘Go far away from
Yahweh. This land has been given to us
for a possession.’
16 “Therefore say, ‘The Lord Yahweh
says: “Whereas I have removed them far
off among the nations, and whereas I
have scattered them among the countries,
yet I will be to them a sanctuary for a little
while in the countries where they have
come.” ’
17 “Therefore say, ‘The Lord Yahweh
says: “I will gather you from the peoples,
and assemble you out of the countries
where you have been scattered, and I will
give you the land of Israel.”
18 “ ‘They will come there, and they will
take away all its detestable things and all
its abominations from there.
19 I will give them one heart, and I will
put a new spirit within them. I will take
the stony heart out of their flesh, and will
give them a heart of flesh,
20 that they may walk in my statutes,
and keep my ordinances, and do them.
They will be my people, and I will be their
God.
21 But as for them whose heart walks
after the heart of their detestable things
and their abominations, I will bring their
way on their own heads,’ says the Lord
Yahweh.”
22 Then the cherubim lifted up their
wings, and the wheels were beside them.
The glory of the God of Israel was over
them above.
23 Yahweh’s glory went up from the
middle of the city, and stood on the
mountain which is on the east side of the
city.
24 The Spirit lifted me up, and brought
me in the vision by the Spirit of God into
Chaldea, to the captives.

So the vision that I had seen went up
from me.

25 Then I spoke to the captives all the
things that Yahweh had shown me.

12

1 Yahweh’s word also came to me,
saying,
2 “Son of man, you dwell in the middle
of the rebellious house, who have eyes to
see, and don’t see, who have ears to hear,
and don’t hear; for they are a rebellious
house.
3 “Therefore, you son of man, prepare
your baggage for moving, and move by
day in their sight. You shall move from
your place to another place in their sight.
It may be they will consider, though they
are a rebellious house.
4 You shall bring out your baggage by
day in their sight, as baggage for moving.
You shall go out yourself at evening in
their sight, as when men go out into exile.
5 Dig through the wall in their sight, and
carry your baggage out that way.
6 In their sight you shall bear it on your
shoulder, and carry it out in the dark. You
shall cover your face, so that you don’t see
the land, for I have set you for a sign to the
house of Israel.”
7 I did so as I was commanded. I
brought out my baggage by day, as
baggage for moving, and in the evening I
dug through the wall with my hand. I
brought it out in the dark, and bore it on
my shoulder in their sight.
8 In the morning, Yahweh’s word came
to me, saying,
9 “Son of man, hasn’t the house of Israel,
the rebellious house, said to you, ‘What
are you doing?’
10 “Say to them, ‘The Lord Yahweh says:
“This burden concerns the prince in
Jerusalem, and all the house of Israel
among whom they are.” ’
11 “Say, ‘I am your sign. As I have done,
so will it be done to them. They will go
into exile, into captivity.
12 “ ‘The prince who is among them will
bear his baggage on his shoulder in the
dark, and will go out. They will dig
through the wall to carry things out that

way. He will cover his face, because he will not see the land with his eyes.
13 I will also spread my net on him, and he will be taken in my snare. I will bring him to Babylon to the land of the Chaldeans; yet he will not see it, though he will die there.
14 I will scatter toward every wind all who are around him to help him, and all his bands. I will draw out the sword after them.
15 " 'They will know that I am Yahweh when I disperse them among the nations and scatter them through the countries.
16 But I will leave a few men of them from the sword, from the famine, and from the pestilence, that they may declare all their abominations among the nations where they come. Then they will know that I am Yahweh.' "
17 Moreover Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
18 "Son of man, eat your bread with quaking, and drink your water with trembling and with fearfulness.
19 Tell the people of the land, 'The Lord Yahweh says concerning the inhabitants of Jerusalem and the land of Israel: "They will eat their bread with fearfulness and drink their water in dismay, that her land may be desolate, and all that is therein, because of the violence of all those who dwell therein.
20 The cities that are inhabited will be laid waste, and the land will be a desolation. Then you will know that I am Yahweh." ' "
21 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
22 "Son of man, what is this proverb that you have in the land of Israel, saying, 'The days are prolonged, and every vision fails'?
23 Tell them therefore, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "I will make this proverb to cease, and they will no more use it as a proverb in Israel;" ' but tell them, ' "The days are at hand, and the fulfillment of every vision.
24 For there will be no more any false vision nor flattering divination within the house of Israel.
25 For I am Yahweh. I will speak, and the word that I speak will be performed. It will be no more deferred; for in your days, rebellious house, I will speak the word and will perform it," says the Lord Yahweh.' "
26 Again Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
27 "Son of man, behold, they of the house of Israel say, 'The vision that he sees is for many days to come, and he prophesies of times that are far off.'
28 "Therefore tell them, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "None of my words will be deferred any more, but the word which I speak will be performed," says the Lord Yahweh.' "

13

1 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
2 "Son of man, prophesy against the prophets of Israel who prophesy, and say to those who prophesy out of their own heart, 'Hear Yahweh's word:
3 The Lord Yahweh says, "Woe to the foolish prophets, who follow their own spirit, and have seen nothing!
4 Israel, your prophets have been like foxes in the waste places.
5 You have not gone up into the gaps or built up the wall for the house of Israel, to stand in the battle in Yahweh's day.
6 They have seen falsehood and lying divination, who say, 'Yahweh says;' but Yahweh has not sent them. They have made men to hope that the word would be confirmed.
7 Haven't you seen a false vision, and haven't you spoken a lying divination, in that you say, 'Yahweh says;' but I have not spoken?"
8 " 'Therefore the Lord Yahweh says: "Because you have spoken falsehood and seen lies, therefore, behold, I am against you," says the Lord Yahweh.
9 "My hand will be against the prophets who see false visions and who utter lying divinations. They will not be in the council of my people, neither will they be written in the writing of the house of Israel, neither will they enter into the land of Israel. Then you will know that I am the Lord Yahweh."

10 “ ‘Because, even because they have
seduced my people, saying, “Peace;” and
there is no peace. When one builds up a
wall, behold, they plaster it with
whitewash.
11 Tell those who plaster it with
whitewash that it will fall. There will be
an overflowing shower; and you, great
hailstones, will fall. A stormy wind will
tear it.
12 Behold, when the wall has fallen,
won’t it be said to you, “Where is the
plaster with which you have plastered it?”
13 “ ‘Therefore the Lord Yahweh says: “I
will even tear it with a stormy wind in my
wrath. There will be an overflowing
shower in my anger, and great hailstones
in wrath to consume it.
14 So I will break down the wall that you
have plastered with whitewash, and bring
it down to the ground, so that its
foundation will be uncovered. It will fall,
and you will be consumed in the middle of
it. Then you will know that I am Yahweh.
15 Thus I will accomplish my wrath on
the wall, and on those who have plastered
it with whitewash. I will tell you, ‘The wall
is no more, nor those who plastered it—
16 to wit, the prophets of Israel who
prophesy concerning Jerusalem, and who
see visions of peace for her, and there is
no peace,’ ” says the Lord Yahweh.’ ”
17 You, son of man, set your face against
the daughters of your people, who
prophesy out of their own heart; and
prophesy against them,
18 and say, “The Lord Yahweh says:
‘Woe to the women who sew magic bands
on all elbows and make veils for the head
of persons of every stature to hunt souls!
Will you hunt the souls of my people and
save souls alive for yourselves?
19 You have profaned me among my
people for handfuls of barley and for
pieces of bread, to kill the souls who
should not die and to save the souls alive
who should not live, by your lying to my
people who listen to lies.’
20 “Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
‘Behold, I am against your magic bands,
with which you hunt the souls to make
them fly, and I will tear them from your
arms. I will let the souls fly free, even the
souls whom you ensnare like birds.
21 I will also tear your veils and deliver
my people out of your hand; and they will
no longer be in your hand to be ensnared.
Then you will know that I am Yahweh.
22 Because with lies you have grieved
the heart of the righteous, whom I have
not made sad; and strengthened the
hands of the wicked, that he should not
return from his wicked way, and be saved
alive.
23 Therefore you shall no more see false
visions nor practice divination. I will
deliver my people out of your hand. Then
you will know that I am Yahweh.’ ”

14

1 Then some of the elders of Israel came
to me and sat before me.
2 Yahweh’s word came to me, saying,
3 “Son of man, these men have taken
their idols into their heart, and put the
stumbling block of their iniquity before
their face. Should I be inquired of at all by
them?
4 Therefore speak to them and tell them,
‘The Lord Yahweh says: “Every man of the
house of Israel who takes his idols into his
heart and puts the stumbling block of his
iniquity before his face then comes to the
prophet, I Yahweh will answer him there
according to the multitude of his idols,
5 that I may take the house of Israel in
their own heart, because they are all
estranged from me through their idols.” ’
6 “Therefore tell the house of Israel, ‘The
Lord Yahweh says: “Return, and turn
yourselves from your idols! Turn away
your faces from all your abominations.
7 “ ‘ “For everyone of the house of Israel,
or of the strangers who live in Israel, who
separates himself from me and takes his
idols into his heart, and puts the
stumbling block of his iniquity before his
face, and comes to the prophet to inquire
for himself of me, I Yahweh will answer
him by myself.
8 I will set my face against that man and
will make him an astonishment, for a sign
and a proverb, and I will cut him off from

among my people. Then you will know that I am Yahweh.
9 “ ‘ “If the prophet is deceived and speaks a word, I, Yahweh, have deceived that prophet, and I will stretch out my hand on him, and will destroy him from among my people Israel.
10 They will bear their iniquity. The iniquity of the prophet will be even as the iniquity of him who seeks him,
11 that the house of Israel may no more go astray from me, neither defile themselves any more with all their transgressions; but that they may be my people, and I may be their God,” says the Lord Yahweh.’ ”
12 Yahweh’s word came to me, saying,
13 “Son of man, when a land sins against me by committing a trespass, and I stretch out my hand on it, and break the staff of its bread and send famine on it, and cut off from it man and animal—
14 though these three men, Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it, they would deliver only their own souls by their righteousness,” says the Lord Yahweh.
15 “If I cause evil animals to pass through the land, and they ravage it and it is made desolate, so that no man may pass through because of the animals—
16 though these three men were in it, as I live,” says the Lord Yahweh, “they would deliver neither sons nor daughters. They only would be delivered, but the land would be desolate.
17 “Or if I bring a sword on that land, and say, ‘Sword, go through the land, so that I cut off from it man and animal’—
18 though these three men were in it, as I live,” says the Lord Yahweh, “they would deliver neither sons nor daughters, but they only would be delivered themselves.
19 “Or if I send a pestilence into that land, and pour out my wrath on it in blood, to cut off from it man and animal—
20 though Noah, Daniel, and Job, were in it, as I live,” says the Lord Yahweh, “they would deliver neither son nor daughter; they would deliver only their own souls by their righteousness.”
21 For the Lord Yahweh says: “How much more when I send my four severe judgments on Jerusalem—the sword, the famine, the evil animals, and the pestilence—to cut off from it man and animal!
22 Yet, behold, there will be left a remnant in it that will be carried out, both sons and daughters. Behold, they will come out to you, and you will see their way and their doings. Then you will be comforted concerning the evil that I have brought on Jerusalem, even concerning all that I have brought on it.
23 They will comfort you, when you see their way and their doings; then you will know that I have not done all that I have done in it without cause,” says the Lord Yahweh.

15

1 Yahweh’s word came to me, saying,
2 “Son of man, what is the vine tree more than any tree, the vine branch which is among the trees of the forest?
3 Will wood be taken of it to make anything? Will men take a pin of it to hang any vessel on it?
4 Behold, it is cast into the fire for fuel; the fire has devoured both its ends, and the middle of it is burned. Is it profitable for any work?
5 Behold, when it was whole, it was suitable for no work. How much less, when the fire has devoured it, and it has been burned, will it yet be suitable for any work?”
6 Therefore the Lord Yahweh says: “As the vine wood among the trees of the forest, which I have given to the fire for fuel, so I will give the inhabitants of Jerusalem.
7 I will set my face against them. They will go out from the fire, but the fire will still devour them. Then you will know that I am Yahweh, when I set my face against them.
8 I will make the land desolate, because they have acted unfaithfully,” says the Lord Yahweh.

16

1 Again Yahweh's word came to me,
saying,
2 "Son of man, cause Jerusalem to know
her abominations;
3 and say, 'The Lord Yahweh says to
Jerusalem: "Your origin and your birth is
of the land of the Canaanite. An Amorite
was your father, and your mother was a
Hittite.
4 As for your birth, in the day you were
born your navel was not cut. You weren't
washed in water to cleanse you. You
weren't salted at all, nor wrapped in
blankets at all.
5 No eye pitied you, to do any of these
things to you, to have compassion on you;
but you were cast out in the open field,
because you were abhorred in the day
that you were born.
6 " ' "When I passed by you, and saw you
wallowing in your blood, I said to you,
'Though you are in your blood, live!' Yes, I
said to you, 'Though you are in your
blood, live!'
7 I caused you to multiply as that which
grows in the field, and you increased and
grew great, and you attained to excellent
beauty. Your breasts were formed, and
your hair grew; yet you were naked and
bare.
8 " ' "Now when I passed by you, and
looked at you, behold, your time was the
time of love; and I spread my garment
over you and covered your nakedness.
Yes, I pledged myself to you and entered
into a covenant with you," says the Lord
Yahweh, "and you became mine.
9 " ' "Then I washed you with water. Yes,
I thoroughly washed away your blood
from you, and I anointed you with oil.
10 I clothed you also with embroidered
work and put leather sandals on you. I
dressed you with fine linen and covered
you with silk.
11 I decked you with ornaments, put
bracelets on your hands, and put a chain
on your neck.
12 I put a ring on your nose, earrings in
your ears, and a beautiful crown on your
head.
13 Thus you were decked with gold and
silver. Your clothing was of fine linen, silk,
and embroidered work. You ate fine flour,
honey, and oil. You were exceedingly
beautiful, and you prospered to royal
estate.
14 Your renown went out among the
nations for your beauty; for it was perfect,
through my majesty which I had put on
you," says the Lord Yahweh.
15 " ' "But you trusted in your beauty,
and played the prostitute because of your
renown, and poured out your prostitution
on everyone who passed by. It was his.
16 You took some of your garments, and
made for yourselves high places decked
with various colors, and played the
prostitute on them. This shouldn't
happen, neither shall it be.
17 You also took your beautiful jewels of
my gold and of my silver, which I had
given you, and made for yourself images
of men, and played the prostitute with
them.
18 You took your embroidered
garments, covered them, and set my oil
and my incense before them.
19 My bread also which I gave you, fine
flour, oil, and honey, with which I fed you,
you even set it before them for a pleasant
aroma; and so it was," says the Lord
Yahweh.
20 " ' "Moreover you have taken your
sons and your daughters, whom you have
borne to me, and you have sacrificed
these to them to be devoured. Was your
prostitution a small matter,
21 that you have slain my children and
delivered them up, in causing them to
pass through the fire to them?
22 In all your abominations and your
prostitution you have not remembered
the days of your youth, when you were
naked and bare, and were wallowing in
your blood.
23 " ' "It has happened after all your
wickedness—woe, woe to you!" says the
Lord Yahweh—
24 "that you have built for yourselves a
vaulted place, and have made yourselves
a lofty place in every street.

25 You have built your lofty place at the
head of every way, and have made your
beauty an abomination, and have opened
your feet to everyone who passed by, and
multiplied your prostitution.
26 You have also committed sexual
immorality with the Egyptians, your
neighbors, great of flesh; and have
multiplied your prostitution, to provoke
me to anger.
27 See therefore, I have stretched out my
hand over you, and have diminished your
portion, and delivered you to the will of
those who hate you, the daughters of the
Philistines, who are ashamed of your
lewd way.
28 You have played the prostitute also
with the Assyrians, because you were
insatiable; yes, you have played the
prostitute with them, and yet you weren't
satisfied.
29 You have moreover multiplied your
prostitution to the land of merchants, to
Chaldea; and yet you weren't satisfied
with this.
30 " ' "How weak is your heart," says the
Lord Yahweh, "since you do all these
things, the work of an impudent
prostitute;
31 in that you build your vaulted place at
the head of every way, and make your
lofty place in every street, and have not
been as a prostitute, in that you scorn pay.
32 " ' "Adulterous wife, who takes
strangers instead of her husband!
33 People give gifts to all prostitutes; but
you give your gifts to all your lovers, and
bribe them, that they may come to you on
every side for your prostitution.
34 You are different from other women
in your prostitution, in that no one follows
you to play the prostitute; and whereas
you give hire, and no hire is given to you,
therefore you are different." '
35 "Therefore, prostitute, hear Yahweh's
word:
36 'The Lord Yahweh says, "Because
your filthiness was poured out, and your
nakedness uncovered through your
prostitution with your lovers; and
because of all the idols of your
abominations, and for the blood of your
children, that you gave to them;
37 therefore see, I will gather all your
lovers, with whom you have taken
pleasure, and all those whom you have
loved, with all those whom you have
hated. I will even gather them against you
on every side, and will uncover your
nakedness to them, that they may see all
your nakedness.
38 I will judge you as women who break
wedlock and shed blood are judged; and I
will bring on you the blood of wrath and
jealousy.
39 I will also give you into their hand,
and they will throw down your vaulted
place, and break down your lofty places.
They will strip you of your clothes and
take your beautiful jewels. They will leave
you naked and bare.
40 They will also bring up a company
against you, and they will stone you with
stones, and thrust you through with their
swords.
41 They will burn your houses with fire,
and execute judgments on you in the sight
of many women. I will cause you to cease
from playing the prostitute, and you will
also give no hire any more.
42 So I will cause my wrath toward you
to rest, and my jealousy will depart from
you. I will be quiet, and will not be angry
any more.

43 " ' "Because you have not
remembered the days of your youth, but
have raged against me in all these things;
therefore, behold, I also will bring your
way on your head," says the Lord Yahweh:
"and you shall not commit this lewdness
with all your abominations.

44 " ' "Behold, everyone who uses
proverbs will use this proverb against
you, saying, 'As is the mother, so is her
daughter.'
45 You are the daughter of your mother,
who loathes her husband and her
children; and you are the sister of your
sisters, who loathed their husbands and
their children. Your mother was a Hittite,
and your father an Amorite.

46 Your elder sister is Samaria, who
dwells at your left hand, she and her
daughters; and your younger sister, who
dwells at your right hand, is Sodom with
her daughters.
47 Yet you have not walked in their
ways, nor done their abominations; but
soon you were more corrupt than they in
all your ways.
48 As I live," says the Lord Yahweh,
"Sodom your sister has not done, she nor
her daughters, as you have done, you and
your daughters.
49 " ' "Behold, this was the iniquity of
your sister Sodom: pride, fullness of
bread, and prosperous ease was in her
and in her daughters. She also didn't
strengthen the hand of the poor and
needy.
50 They were arrogant and committed
abomination before me. Therefore I took
them away when I saw it.
51 Samaria hasn't committed half of
your sins; but you have multiplied your
abominations more than they, and have
justified your sisters by all your
abominations which you have done.
52 You also bear your own shame
yourself, in that you have given judgment
for your sisters; through your sins that
you have committed more abominable
than they, they are more righteous than
you. Yes, be also confounded, and bear
your shame, in that you have justified
your sisters.
53 " ' "I will reverse their captivity, the
captivity of Sodom and her daughters,
and the captivity of Samaria and her
daughters, and the captivity of your
captives among them;
54 that you may bear your own shame,
and may be ashamed because of all that
you have done, in that you are a comfort
to them.
55 Your sisters, Sodom and her
daughters, will return to their former
estate; and Samaria and her daughters
will return to their former estate; and you
and your daughters will return to your
former estate.
56 For your sister Sodom was not
mentioned by your mouth in the day of
your pride,
57 before your wickedness was
uncovered, as at the time of the reproach
of the daughters of Syria, and of all who
are around her, the daughters of the
Philistines, who despise you all around.
58 You have borne your lewdness and
your abominations," says Yahweh.
59 " 'For the Lord Yahweh says: "I will
also deal with you as you have done, who
have despised the oath in breaking the
covenant.
60 Nevertheless I will remember my
covenant with you in the days of your
youth, and I will establish an everlasting
covenant with you.
61 Then you will remember your ways
and be ashamed when you receive your
sisters, your elder sisters and your
younger; and I will give them to you for
daughters, but not by your covenant.
62 I will establish my covenant with you.
Then you will know that I am Yahweh;
63 that you may remember, and be
confounded, and never open your mouth
any more because of your shame, when I
have forgiven you all that you have done,"
says the Lord Yahweh.' "

17

1 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
2 "Son of man, tell a riddle, and speak a
parable to the house of Israel;
3 and say, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "A
great eagle with great wings and long
feathers, full of feathers which had
various colors, came to Lebanon and took
the top of the cedar.
4 He cropped off the topmost of its
young twigs, and carried it to a land of
traffic. He planted it in a city of
merchants.
5 " ' "He also took some of the seed of the
land and planted it in fruitful soil. He
placed it beside many waters. He set it as
a willow tree.
6 It grew and became a spreading vine
of low stature, whose branches turned
toward him, and its roots were under

him. So it became a vine, produced
branches, and shot out sprigs.
7 “ ‘ “There was also another great eagle
with great wings and many feathers.
Behold, this vine bent its roots toward
him, and shot out its branches toward
him, from the ground where it was
planted, that he might water it.
8 It was planted in a good soil by many
waters, that it might produce branches
and that it might bear fruit, that it might
be a good vine.” ’
9 “Say, ‘The Lord Yahweh says: “Will it
prosper? Won’t he pull up its roots and
cut off its fruit, that it may wither, that all
its fresh springing leaves may wither? It
can’t be raised from its roots by a strong
arm or many people.
10 Yes, behold, being planted, will it
prosper? Won’t it utterly wither when the
east wind touches it? It will wither in the
ground where it grew.” ’ ”
11 Moreover Yahweh’s word came to
me, saying,
12 “Say now to the rebellious house,
‘Don’t you know what these things mean?’
Tell them, ‘Behold, the king of Babylon
came to Jerusalem, and took its king, and
its princes, and brought them to him to
Babylon.
13 He took one of the royal offspring,†
and made a covenant with him. He also
brought him under an oath, and took
away the mighty of the land,
14 that the kingdom might be brought
low, that it might not lift itself up, but that
by keeping his covenant it might stand.
15 But he rebelled against him in
sending his ambassadors into Egypt, that
they might give him horses and many
people. Will he prosper? Will he who does
such things escape? Will he break the
covenant, and still escape?
16 “ ‘As I live,’ says the Lord Yahweh,
‘surely in the place where the king dwells
who made him king, whose oath he
despised, and whose covenant he broke,
even with him in the middle of Babylon
he will die.
17 Pharaoh with his mighty army and
great company won’t help him in the war,
when they cast up mounds and build forts
to cut off many persons.
18 For he has despised the oath by
breaking the covenant; and behold, he
had given his hand, and yet has done all
these things. He won’t escape.
19 “Therefore the Lord Yahweh says: ‘As
I live, I will surely bring on his own head
my oath that he has despised and my
covenant that he has broken.
20 I will spread my net on him, and he
will be taken in my snare. I will bring him
to Babylon, and will enter into judgment
with him there for his trespass that he has
trespassed against me.
21 All his fugitives in all his bands will
fall by the sword, and those who remain
will be scattered toward every wind.
Then you will know that I, Yahweh, have
spoken it.’
22 “The Lord Yahweh says: ‘I will also
take some of the lofty top of the cedar, and
will plant it. I will crop off from the
topmost of its young twigs a tender one,
and I will plant it on a high and lofty
mountain.
23 I will plant it in the mountain of the
height of Israel; and it will produce
boughs, and bear fruit, and be a good
cedar. Birds of every kind will dwell in
the shade of its branches.
24 All the trees of the field will know that
I, Yahweh, have brought down the high
tree, have exalted the low tree, have dried
up the green tree, and have made the dry
tree flourish.
“ ‘I, Yahweh, have spoken and have
done it.’ ”

18

1 Yahweh’s word came to me again,
saying,
2 “What do you mean, that you use this
proverb concerning the land of Israel,
saying,
‘The fathers have eaten sour grapes,
and the children’s teeth are set on
edge’?

† **17:13** or, seed

3 “As I live,” says the Lord Yahweh, “you
shall not use this proverb any more in
Israel.
4 Behold, all souls are mine; as the soul
of the father, so also the soul of the son is
mine. The soul who sins, he shall die.

5 “But if a man is just,
and does that which is lawful and
right,
6 and has not eaten on the mountains,
hasn’t lifted up his eyes to the idols of
the house of Israel,
hasn’t defiled his neighbor’s wife,
hasn’t come near a woman in her
impurity,
7 and has not wronged any,
but has restored to the debtor his
pledge,
has taken nothing by robbery,
has given his bread to the hungry,
and has covered the naked with a
garment;
8 he who hasn’t lent to them with interest,
hasn’t taken any increase from them,
who has withdrawn his hand from
iniquity,
has executed true justice between
man and man,
9 has walked in my statutes,
and has kept my ordinances,
to deal truly;
he is just,
he shall surely live,” says the Lord
Yahweh.

10 “If he fathers a son who is a robber
who sheds blood, and who does any one
of these things,
11 or who does not do any of those things
but has eaten at the mountain shrines
and defiled his neighbor’s wife,
12 has wronged the poor and needy,
has taken by robbery,
has not restored the pledge,
and has lifted up his eyes to the idols,
has committed abomination,
13 has lent with interest,
and has taken increase from the poor,
shall he then live? He shall not live. He
has done all these abominations. He shall
surely die. His blood will be on him.

14 “Now, behold, if he fathers a son who
sees all his father’s sins which he has
done, and fears, and doesn’t do likewise,
15 who hasn’t eaten on the mountains,
hasn’t lifted up his eyes to the idols of
the house of Israel,
hasn’t defiled his neighbor’s wife,
16 hasn’t wronged any,
hasn’t taken anything to pledge,
hasn’t taken by robbery,
but has given his bread to the hungry,
and has covered the naked with a
garment;
17 who has withdrawn his hand from the
poor,
who hasn’t received interest or
increase,
has executed my ordinances,
has walked in my statutes;
he shall not die for the iniquity of his
father. He shall surely live.
18 As for his father, because he cruelly
oppressed, robbed his brother, and did
that which is not good among his people,
behold, he will die in his iniquity.
19 “Yet you say, ‘Why doesn’t the son
bear the iniquity of the father?’ When the
son has done that which is lawful and
right, and has kept all my statutes, and has
done them, he will surely live.
20 The soul who sins, he shall die. The
son shall not bear the iniquity of the
father, neither shall the father bear the
iniquity of the son. The righteousness of
the righteous shall be on him, and the
wickedness of the wicked shall be on him.
21 “But if the wicked turns from all his
sins that he has committed, and keeps all
my statutes, and does that which is lawful
and right, he shall surely live. He shall not
die.
22 None of his transgressions that he has
committed will be remembered against
him. In his righteousness that he has
done, he shall live.
23 Have I any pleasure in the death of
the wicked?” says the Lord Yahweh, “and
not rather that he should return from his
way, and live?
24 “But when the righteous turns away
from his righteousness, and commits
iniquity, and does according to all the

abominations that the wicked man does, should he live? None of his righteous deeds that he has done will be remembered. In his trespass that he has trespassed, and in his sin that he has sinned, in them he shall die.
25 “Yet you say, ‘The way of the Lord is not equal.’ Hear now, house of Israel: Is my way not equal? Aren’t your ways unequal?
26 When the righteous man turns away from his righteousness, and commits iniquity, and dies in it, then he dies in his iniquity that he has done.
27 Again, when the wicked man turns away from his wickedness that he has committed, and does that which is lawful and right, he will save his soul alive.
28 Because he considers, and turns away from all his transgressions that he has committed, he shall surely live. He shall not die.
29 Yet the house of Israel says, ‘The way of the Lord is not fair.’ House of Israel, aren’t my ways fair? Aren’t your ways unfair?
30 “Therefore I will judge you, house of Israel, everyone according to his ways,” says the Lord Yahweh. “Return, and turn yourselves from all your transgressions, so iniquity will not be your ruin.
31 Cast away from you all your transgressions in which you have transgressed; and make yourself a new heart and a new spirit. For why will you die, house of Israel?
32 For I have no pleasure in the death of him who dies,” says the Lord Yahweh. “Therefore turn yourselves, and live!

19

1 “Moreover, take up a lamentation for the princes of Israel,
2 and say,
‘What was your mother?
A lioness.
She couched among lions,
in the middle of the young lions she nourished her cubs.
3 She brought up one of her cubs.
He became a young lion.
He learned to catch the prey.
He devoured men.
4 The nations also heard of him.
He was taken in their pit;
and they brought him with hooks to the land of Egypt.

5 “ ‘Now when she saw that she had waited,
and her hope was lost,
then she took another of her cubs,
and made him a young lion.
6 He went up and down among the lions.
He became a young lion.
He learned to catch the prey.
He devoured men.
7 He knew their palaces,
and laid waste their cities.
The land was desolate with its fullness,
because of the noise of his roaring.
8 Then the nations attacked him on every side from the provinces.
They spread their net over him.
He was taken in their pit.
9 They put him in a cage with hooks,
and brought him to the king of Babylon.
They brought him into strongholds,
so that his voice should no more be heard on the mountains of Israel.

10 “ ‘Your mother was like a vine in your blood, planted by the waters.
It was fruitful and full of branches by reason of many waters.
11 It had strong branches for the scepters of those who ruled.
Their stature was exalted among the thick boughs.
They were seen in their height
with the multitude of their branches.
12 But it was plucked up in fury.
It was cast down to the ground,
and the east wind dried up its fruit.
Its strong branches were broken off and withered.
The fire consumed them.
13 Now it is planted in the wilderness,
in a dry and thirsty land.
14 Fire has gone out of its branches.
It has devoured its fruit,
so that there is in it no strong branch to be a scepter to rule.’

This is a lamentation, and shall be for a lamentation."

20

1 In the seventh year, in the fifth month, the tenth day of the month, some of the elders of Israel came to inquire of Yahweh, and sat before me.
2 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
3 "Son of man, speak to the elders of Israel, and tell them, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "Is it to inquire of me that you have come? As I live," says the Lord Yahweh, "I will not be inquired of by you." '
4 "Will you judge them, son of man? Will you judge them? Cause them to know the abominations of their fathers.
5 Tell them, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "In the day when I chose Israel, and swore to the offspring of the house of Jacob, and made myself known to them in the land of Egypt, when I swore to them, saying, 'I am Yahweh your God;'
6 in that day I swore to them to bring them out of the land of Egypt into a land that I had searched out for them, flowing with milk and honey, which is the glory of all lands.
7 I said to them, 'Each of you throw away the abominations of his eyes. Don't defile yourselves with the idols of Egypt. I am Yahweh your God.'
8 " ' "But they rebelled against me and wouldn't listen to me. They didn't all throw away the abominations of their eyes. They also didn't forsake the idols of Egypt. Then I said I would pour out my wrath on them, to accomplish my anger against them in the middle of the land of Egypt.
9 But I worked for my name's sake, that it should not be profaned in the sight of the nations among which they were, in whose sight I made myself known to them in bringing them out of the land of Egypt.
10 So I caused them to go out of the land of Egypt and brought them into the wilderness.
11 I gave them my statutes and showed them my ordinances, which if a man does, he will live in them.
12 Moreover also I gave them my Sabbaths, to be a sign between me and them, that they might know that I am Yahweh who sanctifies them.
13 " ' "But the house of Israel rebelled against me in the wilderness. They didn't walk in my statutes and they rejected my ordinances, which if a man keeps, he shall live in them. They greatly profaned my Sabbaths. Then I said I would pour out my wrath on them in the wilderness, to consume them.
14 But I worked for my name's sake, that it should not be profaned in the sight of the nations, in whose sight I brought them out.
15 Moreover also I swore to them in the wilderness that I would not bring them into the land which I had given them, flowing with milk and honey, which is the glory of all lands,
16 because they rejected my ordinances, and didn't walk in my statutes, and profaned my Sabbaths; for their heart went after their idols.
17 Nevertheless my eye spared them, and I didn't destroy them. I didn't make a full end of them in the wilderness.
18 I said to their children in the wilderness, 'Don't walk in the statutes of your fathers. Don't observe their ordinances or defile yourselves with their idols.
19 I am Yahweh your God. Walk in my statutes, keep my ordinances, and do them.
20 Make my Sabbaths holy. They shall be a sign between me and you, that you may know that I am Yahweh your God.'
21 " ' "But the children rebelled against me. They didn't walk in my statutes, and didn't keep my ordinances to do them, which if a man does, he shall live in them. They profaned my Sabbaths. Then I said I would pour out my wrath on them, to accomplish my anger against them in the wilderness.
22 Nevertheless I withdrew my hand and worked for my name's sake, that it should not be profaned in the sight of the nations, in whose sight I brought them out.

23 Moreover I swore to them in the
wilderness, that I would scatter them
among the nations and disperse them
through the countries,
24 because they had not executed my
ordinances, but had rejected my statutes,
and had profaned my Sabbaths, and their
eyes were after their fathers' idols.
25 Moreover also I gave them statutes
that were not good, and ordinances in
which they couldn't live.
26 I polluted them in their own gifts, in
that they caused all that opens the womb
to pass through the fire, that I might make
them desolate, to the end that they might
know that I am Yahweh." '
27 "Therefore, son of man, speak to the
house of Israel, and tell them, 'The Lord
Yahweh says: "Moreover, in this your
fathers have blasphemed me, in that they
have committed a trespass against me.
28 For when I had brought them into the
land which I swore to give to them, then
they saw every high hill and every thick
tree, and they offered there their
sacrifices, and there they presented the
provocation of their offering. There they
also made their pleasant aroma, and there
they poured out their drink offerings.
29 Then I said to them, 'What does the
high place where you go mean?' So its
name is called Bamah† to this day." '
30 "Therefore tell the house of Israel,
'The Lord Yahweh says: "Do you pollute
yourselves in the way of your fathers? Do
you play the prostitute after their
abominations?
31 When you offer your gifts, when you
make your sons pass through the fire, do
you pollute yourselves with all your idols
to this day? Should I be inquired of by you,
house of Israel? As I live, says the Lord
Yahweh, I will not be inquired of by you!
32 " ' "That which comes into your mind
will not be at all, in that you say, 'We will
be as the nations, as the families of the
countries, to serve wood and stone.'
33 As I live," says the Lord Yahweh,
"surely with a mighty hand, with an
outstretched arm, and with wrath poured
out, I will be king over you.
34 I will bring you out from the peoples,
and will gather you out of the countries in
which you are scattered with a mighty
hand, with an outstretched arm, and with
wrath poured out.
35 I will bring you into the wilderness of
the peoples, and there I will enter into
judgment with you face to face.
36 Just as I entered into judgment with
your fathers in the wilderness of the land
of Egypt, so I will enter into judgment
with you," says the Lord Yahweh.
37 "I will cause you to pass under the
rod, and I will bring you into the bond of
the covenant.
38 I will purge out from among you the
rebels and those who disobey me. I will
bring them out of the land where they
live, but they shall not enter into the land
of Israel. Then you will know that I am
Yahweh."
39 " 'As for you, house of Israel, the Lord
Yahweh says: "Go, everyone serve his
idols, and hereafter also, if you will not
listen to me; but you shall no more
profane my holy name with your gifts and
with your idols.
40 For in my holy mountain, in the
mountain of the height of Israel," says the
Lord Yahweh, "there all the house of
Israel, all of them, shall serve me in the
land. There I will accept them, and there I
will require your offerings and the first
fruits of your offerings, with all your holy
things.
41 I will accept you as a pleasant aroma
when I bring you out from the peoples
and gather you out of the countries in
which you have been scattered. I will be
sanctified in you in the sight of the
nations.
42 You will know that I am Yahweh
when I bring you into the land of Israel,
into the country which I swore to give to
your fathers.
43 There you will remember your ways,
and all your deeds in which you have
polluted yourselves. Then you will loathe

† **20:29** "Bamah" means "High Place".

yourselves in your own sight for all your evils that you have committed.
44 You will know that I am Yahweh,
when I have dealt with you for my name's sake, not according to your evil ways, nor according to your corrupt doings, you house of Israel," says the Lord Yahweh.' "
45 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
46 "Son of man, set your face toward the south, and preach toward the south, and prophesy against the forest of the field in the south.
47 Tell the forest of the south, 'Hear Yahweh's word: The Lord Yahweh says, "Behold, I will kindle a fire in you, and it will devour every green tree in you, and every dry tree. The burning flame will not be quenched, and all faces from the south to the north will be burned by it.
48 All flesh will see that I, Yahweh, have kindled it. It will not be quenched." ' "
49 Then I said, "Ah Lord Yahweh! They say of me, 'Isn't he a speaker of parables?' "

21

1 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
2 "Son of man, set your face toward Jerusalem, and preach toward the sanctuaries, and prophesy against the land of Israel.
3 Tell the land of Israel, 'Yahweh says: "Behold, I am against you, and will draw my sword out of its sheath, and will cut off from you the righteous and the wicked.
4 Seeing then that I will cut off from you the righteous and the wicked, therefore my sword will go out of its sheath against all flesh from the south to the north.
5 All flesh will know that I, Yahweh, have drawn my sword out of its sheath. It will not return any more." '
6 "Therefore sigh, you son of man. You shall sigh before their eyes with a broken heart† and with bitterness.
7 It shall be, when they ask you, 'Why do you sigh?' that you shall say, 'Because of the news, for it comes! Every heart will melt, all hands will be feeble, every spirit will faint, and all knees will be weak as water. Behold, it comes, and it shall be done, says the Lord Yahweh.' "
8 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
9 "Son of man, prophesy, and say, 'Yahweh says:
"A sword! A sword!
It is sharpened,
and also polished.
10 It is sharpened that it may make a slaughter.
It is polished that it may be as lightning.
Should we then make mirth?
The rod of my son condemns every tree.
11 It is given to be polished,
that it may be handled.
The sword is sharpened.
Yes, it is polished
to give it into the hand of the killer." '
12 Cry and wail, son of man;
for it is on my people.
It is on all the princes of Israel.
They are delivered over to the sword with my people.
Therefore beat your thigh.

13 "For there is a trial. What if even the rod that condemns will be no more?" says the Lord Yahweh.
14 "You therefore, son of man, prophesy,
and strike your hands together.
Let the sword be doubled the third time,
the sword of the fatally wounded.
It is the sword of the great one who is fatally wounded,
which enters into their rooms.
15 I have set the threatening sword against all their gates,
that their heart may melt,
and their stumblings be multiplied.
Ah! It is made as lightning.
It is pointed for slaughter.
16 Gather yourselves together.
Go to the right.
Set yourselves in array.
Go to the left,
wherever your face is set.
17 I will also strike my hands together,
and I will cause my wrath to rest.
I, Yahweh, have spoken it."

† **21:6** literally, the breaking of your thighs

18 Yahweh's word came to me again,
saying,
19 "Also, you son of man, appoint two
ways, that the sword of the king of
Babylon may come. They both will come
out of one land, and mark out a place.
Mark it out at the head of the way to the
city.
20 You shall appoint a way for the sword
to come to Rabbah of the children of
Ammon, and to Judah in Jerusalem the
fortified.
21 For the king of Babylon stood at the
parting of the way, at the head of the two
ways, to use divination. He shook the
arrows back and forth. He consulted the
teraphim.‡ He looked in the liver.
22 In his right hand was the lot for
Jerusalem, to set battering rams, to open
the mouth in the slaughter, to lift up the
voice with shouting, to set battering rams
against the gates, to cast up mounds, and
to build forts.
23 It will be to them as a false divination
in their sight, who have sworn oaths to
them; but he brings iniquity to memory,
that they may be taken.
24 "Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
'Because you have caused your iniquity to
be remembered, in that your
transgressions are uncovered, so that in
all your doings your sins appear; because
you have come to memory, you will be
taken with the hand.
25 " 'You, deadly wounded wicked one,
the prince of Israel, whose day has come,
in the time of the iniquity of the end,
26 the Lord Yahweh says: "Remove the
turban, and take off the crown. This will
not be as it was. Exalt that which is low,
and humble that which is high.
27 I will overturn, overturn, overturn it.
This also will be no more, until he comes
whose right it is; and I will give it." '
28 "You, son of man, prophesy and say,
'The Lord Yahweh says this concerning
the children of Ammon, and concerning
their reproach:
"A sword! A sword is drawn!
It is polished for the slaughter,
to cause it to devour,
that it may be as lightning;
29 while they see for you false visions,
while they divine lies to you,
to lay you on the necks of the wicked who
are deadly wounded,
whose day has come in the time of the
iniquity of the end.
30 Cause it to return into its sheath.
In the place where you were created,
in the land of your birth, I will judge
you.
31 I will pour out my indignation on you.
I will blow on you with the fire of my
wrath.
I will deliver you into the hand of brutish
men,
skillful to destroy.
32 You will be for fuel to the fire.
Your blood will be in the middle of the
land.
You will be remembered no more;
for I, Yahweh, have spoken it." ' "

22

1 Moreover Yahweh's word came to me,
saying,
2 "You, son of man, will you judge? Will
you judge the bloody city? Then cause her
to know all her abominations.
3 You shall say, 'The Lord Yahweh says:
"A city that sheds blood within herself,
that her time may come, and that makes
idols against herself to defile her!
4 You have become guilty in your blood
that you have shed, and are defiled in
your idols which you have made! You
have caused your days to draw near, and
have come to the end of your years.
Therefore I have made you a reproach to
the nations, and a mocking to all the
countries.
5 Those who are near and those who are
far from you will mock you, you infamous
one, full of tumult.
6 " ' "Behold, the princes of Israel,
everyone according to his power, have
been in you to shed blood.

‡ **21:21** teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property. † **22:7** Literally, *made light of father and mother.*

7 In you have they treated father and
mother with contempt.† Among you they
have oppressed the foreigner. In you they
have wronged the fatherless and the
widow.
8 You have despised my holy things, and
have profaned my Sabbaths.
9 Slanderous men have been in you to
shed blood. In you they have eaten on the
mountains. They have committed
lewdness among you.
10 In you have they uncovered their
fathers' nakedness. In you have they
humbled her who was unclean in her
impurity.
11 One has committed abomination with
his neighbor's wife, and another has
lewdly defiled his daughter-in-law.
Another in you has humbled his sister, his
father's daughter.
12 In you have they taken bribes to shed
blood. You have taken interest and
increase, and you have greedily gained of
your neighbors by oppression, and have
forgotten me," says the Lord Yahweh.
13 " ' "Behold, therefore I have struck my
hand at your dishonest gain which you
have made, and at the blood which has
been shed within you.
14 Can your heart endure, or can your
hands be strong, in the days that I will
deal with you? I, Yahweh, have spoken it,
and will do it.
15 I will scatter you among the nations,
and disperse you through the countries. I
will purge your filthiness out of you.
16 You will be profaned in yourself in
the sight of the nations. Then you will
know that I am Yahweh." ' "
17 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
18 "Son of man, the house of Israel has
become dross to me. All of them are
bronze, tin, iron, and lead in the middle of
the furnace. They are the dross of silver.
19 Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
'Because you have all become dross,
therefore, behold, I will gather you into
the middle of Jerusalem.
20 As they gather silver, bronze, iron,
lead, and tin into the middle of the
furnace, to blow the fire on it, to melt it, so
I will gather you in my anger and in my
wrath, and I will lay you there and melt
you.
21 Yes, I will gather you, and blow on
you with the fire of my wrath, and you
will be melted in the middle of it.
22 As silver is melted in the middle of the
furnace, so you will be melted in the
middle of it; and you will know that I,
Yahweh, have poured out my wrath on
you.' "

23 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
24 "Son of man, tell her, 'You are a land
that is not cleansed nor rained on in the
day of indignation.'
25 There is a conspiracy of her prophets
within it, like a roaring lion ravening the
prey. They have devoured souls. They
take treasure and precious things. They
have made many widows within it.
26 Her priests have done violence to my
law and have profaned my holy things.
They have made no distinction between
the holy and the common, neither have
they caused men to discern between the
unclean and the clean, and have hidden
their eyes from my Sabbaths. So I am
profaned among them.
27 Her princes within it are like wolves
ravening the prey, to shed blood and to
destroy souls, that they may get dishonest
gain.
28 Her prophets have plastered for them
with whitewash, seeing false visions, and
divining lies to them, saying, 'The Lord
Yahweh says,' when Yahweh has not
spoken.
29 The people of the land have used
oppression and exercised robbery. Yes,
they have troubled the poor and needy,
and have oppressed the foreigner
wrongfully.

30 "I sought for a man among them who
would build up the wall and stand in the
gap before me for the land, that I would
not destroy it; but I found no one.
31 Therefore I have poured out my
indignation on them. I have consumed
them with the fire of my wrath. I have
brought their own way on their heads,"
says the Lord Yahweh.

23

1 Yahweh's word came again to me,
saying,
2 "Son of man, there were two women,
the daughters of one mother.
3 They played the prostitute in Egypt.
They played the prostitute in their youth.
Their breasts were fondled there, and
their youthful nipples were caressed
there.
4 Their names were Oholah the elder,
and Oholibah her sister. They became
mine, and they bore sons and daughters.
As for their names, Samaria is Oholah,
and Jerusalem Oholibah.

5 "Oholah played the prostitute when
she was mine. She doted on her lovers, on
the Assyrians her neighbors,
6 who were clothed with
blue—governors and rulers, all of them
desirable young men, horsemen riding on
horses.
7 She gave herself as a prostitute to
them, all of them the choicest men of
Assyria. She defiled herself with the idols
of whomever she lusted after.
8 She hasn't left her prostitution since
leaving Egypt; for in her youth they lay
with her. They caressed her youthful
nipples and they poured out their
prostitution on her.

9 "Therefore I delivered her into the
hand of her lovers, into the hand of the
Assyrians on whom she doted.
10 These uncovered her nakedness.
They took her sons and her daughters,
and they killed her with the sword. She
became a byword among women; for they
executed judgments on her.

11 "Her sister Oholibah saw this, yet she
was more corrupt in her lusting than she,
and in her prostitution which was more
depraved than the prostitution of her
sister.
12 She lusted after the Assyrians,
governors and rulers—her neighbors,
clothed most gorgeously, horsemen riding
on horses, all of them desirable young
men.
13 I saw that she was defiled. They both
went the same way.
14 "She increased her prostitution; for
she saw men portrayed on the wall, the
images of the Chaldeans portrayed with
red,
15 dressed with belts on their waists,
with flowing turbans on their heads, all of
them looking like princes, after the
likeness of the Babylonians in Chaldea,
the land of their birth.
16 As soon as she saw them, she lusted
after them and sent messengers to them
into Chaldea.
17 The Babylonians came to her into the
bed of love, and they defiled her with their
prostitution. She was polluted with them,
and her soul was alienated from them.
18 So she uncovered her prostitution
and uncovered her nakedness. Then my
soul was alienated from her, just like my
soul was alienated from her sister.
19 Yet she multiplied her prostitution,
remembering the days of her youth, in
which she had played the prostitute in the
land of Egypt.
20 She lusted after their lovers, whose
flesh is as the flesh of donkeys, and whose
issue is like the issue of horses.
21 Thus you called to memory the
lewdness of your youth, in the caressing
of your nipples by the Egyptians because
of your youthful breasts.
22 "Therefore, Oholibah, the Lord
Yahweh says: 'Behold, I will raise up your
lovers against you, from whom your soul
is alienated, and I will bring them against
you on every side:
23 the Babylonians and all the
Chaldeans, Pekod, Shoa, Koa, and all the
Assyrians with them; all of them desirable
young men, governors and rulers, princes
and men of renown, all of them riding on
horses.
24 They will come against you with
weapons, chariots, and wagons, and with
a company of peoples. They will set
themselves against you with buckler,
shield, and helmet all around. I will
commit the judgment to them, and they
will judge you according to their
judgments.
25 I will set my jealousy against you, and
they will deal with you in fury. They will

take away your nose and your ears. Your
remnant will fall by the sword. They will
take your sons and your daughters; and
the rest of you will be devoured by the
fire.
26 They will also strip you of your
clothes and take away your beautiful
jewels.
27 Thus I will make your lewdness to
cease from you, and remove your
prostitution from the land of Egypt, so
that you will not lift up your eyes to them,
nor remember Egypt any more.'
28 "For the Lord Yahweh says: 'Behold, I
will deliver you into the hand of them
whom you hate, into the hand of them
from whom your soul is alienated.
29 They will deal with you in hatred, and
will take away all your labor, and will
leave you naked and bare. The nakedness
of your prostitution will be uncovered,
both your lewdness and your prostitution.
30 These things will be done to you
because you have played the prostitute
after the nations, and because you are
polluted with their idols.
31 You have walked in the way of your
sister; therefore I will give her cup into
your hand.'
32 "The Lord Yahweh says:
'You will drink of your sister's cup,
which is deep and large.
You will be ridiculed and held in derision.
It contains much.
33 You will be filled with drunkenness and
sorrow,
with the cup of astonishment and
desolation,
with the cup of your sister Samaria.
34 You will even drink it and drain it out.
You will gnaw the broken pieces of it,
and will tear your breasts;
for I have spoken it,' says the Lord
Yahweh.
35 "Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
'Because you have forgotten me and cast
me behind your back, therefore you also
bear your lewdness and your
prostitution.' "
36 Yahweh said moreover to me: "Son of
man, will you judge Oholah and
Oholibah? Then declare to them their
abominations.
37 For they have committed adultery,
and blood is in their hands. They have
committed adultery with their idols. They
have also caused their sons, whom they
bore to me, to pass through the fire to
them to be devoured.
38 Moreover this they have done to me:
they have defiled my sanctuary in the
same day, and have profaned my
Sabbaths.
39 For when they had slain their
children to their idols, then they came the
same day into my sanctuary to profane it;
and behold, they have done this in the
middle of my house.
40 "Furthermore you sisters have sent
for men who come from far away, to
whom a messenger was sent, and behold,
they came; for whom you washed
yourself, painted your eyes, decorated
yourself with ornaments,
41 and sat on a stately bed, with a table
prepared before it, whereupon you set my
incense and my oil.
42 "The voice of a multitude being at
ease was with her. With men of the
common sort were brought drunkards
from the wilderness; and they put
bracelets on their hands, and beautiful
crowns on their heads.
43 Then I said of her who was old in
adulteries, 'Now they will play the
prostitute with her, and she with them.'
44 They went in to her, as they go in to a
prostitute. So they went in to Oholah and
to Oholibah, the lewd women.
45 Righteous men will judge them with
the judgment of adulteresses and with the
judgment of women who shed blood,
because they are adulteresses, and blood
is in their hands.
46 "For the Lord Yahweh says: 'I will
bring up a mob against them, and will
give them to be tossed back and forth and
robbed.
47 The company will stone them with
stones and dispatch them with their
swords. They will kill their sons and their
daughters, and burn up their houses with
fire.

48 “ ‘Thus I will cause lewdness to cease
out of the land, that all women may be
taught not to be lewd like you.
49 They will recompense your lewdness
on you, and you will bear the sins of your
idols. Then you will know that I am the
Lord Yahweh.’ ”

24

1 Again, in the ninth year, in the tenth
month, in the tenth day of the month,
Yahweh’s word came to me, saying,
2 “Son of man, write the name of the
day, this same day. The king of Babylon
drew close to Jerusalem this same day.
3 Utter a parable to the rebellious house,
and tell them, ‘The Lord Yahweh says,
“Put the cauldron on the fire.
Put it on,
and also pour water into it.
4 Gather its pieces into it,
even every good piece:
the thigh and the shoulder.
Fill it with the choice bones.
5 Take the choice of the flock,
and also a pile of wood for the bones
under the cauldron.
Make it boil well.
Yes, let its bones be boiled within it.”
6 “ ‘Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
“Woe to the bloody city,
to the cauldron whose rust is in it,
and whose rust hasn’t gone out of it!
Take out of it piece after piece
without casting lots for it.

7 “ ‘ “For the blood she shed is in the
middle of her.
She set it on the bare rock.
She didn’t pour it on the ground,
to cover it with dust.
8 That it may cause wrath to come up to
take vengeance,
I have set her blood on the bare rock,
that it should not be covered.”
9 “ ‘Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
“Woe to the bloody city!
I also will make the pile great.
10 Heap on the wood.
Make the fire hot.
Boil the meat well.
Make the broth thick,
and let the bones be burned.
11 Then set it empty on its coals,
that it may be hot,
and its bronze may burn,
and that its filthiness may be molten
in it,
that its rust may be consumed.
12 She is weary with toil;
yet her great rust,
rust by fire, doesn’t leave her.
13 “ ‘ “In your filthiness is lewdness.
Because I have cleansed you and you
weren’t cleansed, you won’t be cleansed
from your filthiness any more, until I
have caused my wrath toward you to rest.
14 “ ‘ “I, Yahweh, have spoken it. It will
happen, and I will do it. I won’t go back. I
won’t spare. I won’t repent. According to
your ways and according to your doings,
they will judge you,” says the Lord
Yahweh.’ ”
15 Also Yahweh’s word came to me,
saying,
16 “Son of man, behold, I will take away
from you the desire of your eyes with one
stroke; yet you shall neither mourn nor
weep, neither shall your tears run down.
17 Sigh, but not aloud. Make no
mourning for the dead. Bind your
headdress on you, and put your sandals
on your feet. Don’t cover your lips, and
don’t eat mourner’s bread.”
18 So I spoke to the people in the
morning, and at evening my wife died. So
I did in the morning as I was commanded.
19 The people asked me, “Won’t you tell
us what these things mean to us, that you
act like this?”
20 Then I said to them, “Yahweh’s word
came to me, saying,
21 ‘Speak to the house of Israel, “The
Lord Yahweh says: ‘Behold, I will profane
my sanctuary, the pride of your power,
the desire of your eyes, and that which
your soul pities; and your sons and your
daughters whom you have left behind
will fall by the sword.
22 You will do as I have done. You won’t
cover your lips or eat mourner’s bread.
23 Your turbans will be on your heads,
and your sandals on your feet. You won’t
mourn or weep; but you will pine away in

your iniquities, and moan one toward another.
24 Thus Ezekiel will be a sign to you; according to all that he has done, you will do. When this comes, then you will know that I am the Lord Yahweh.' " ' "
25 "You, son of man, shouldn't it be in the day when I take from them their strength, the joy of their glory, the desire of their eyes, and that whereupon they set their heart—their sons and their daughters—
26 that in that day he who escapes will come to you, to cause you to hear it with your ears?
27 In that day your mouth will be opened to him who has escaped, and you will speak and be no more mute. So you will be a sign to them. Then they will know that I am Yahweh."

25

1 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
2 "Son of man, set your face toward the children of Ammon, and prophesy against them.
3 Tell the children of Ammon, 'Hear the word of the Lord Yahweh! The Lord Yahweh says, "Because you said, 'Aha!' against my sanctuary when it was profaned, and against the land of Israel when it was made desolate, and against the house of Judah when they went into captivity,
4 therefore, behold, I will deliver you to the children of the east for a possession. They will set their encampments in you and make their dwellings in you. They will eat your fruit and they will drink your milk.
5 I will make Rabbah a stable for camels and the children of Ammon a resting place for flocks. Then you will know that I am Yahweh."
6 For the Lord Yahweh says: "Because you have clapped your hands, stamped with the feet, and rejoiced with all the contempt of your soul against the land of Israel,
7 therefore, behold, I have stretched out my hand on you, and will deliver you for a plunder to the nations. I will cut you off from the peoples, and I will cause you to perish out of the countries. I will destroy you. Then you will know that I am Yahweh."
8 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "Because Moab and Seir say, 'Behold, the house of Judah is like all the nations,'
9 therefore, behold, I will open the side of Moab from the cities, from his cities which are on its frontiers, the glory of the country, Beth Jeshimoth, Baal Meon, and Kiriathaim,
10 to the children of the east, to go against the children of Ammon; and I will give them for a possession, that the children of Ammon may not be remembered among the nations.
11 I will execute judgments on Moab. Then they will know that I am Yahweh."
12 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "Because Edom has dealt against the house of Judah by taking vengeance, and has greatly offended, and taken revenge on them,"
13 therefore the Lord Yahweh says, "I will stretch out my hand on Edom, and will cut off man and animal from it; and I will make it desolate from Teman. They will fall by the sword even to Dedan.
14 I will lay my vengeance on Edom by the hand of my people Israel. They will do in Edom according to my anger and according to my wrath. Then they will know my vengeance," says the Lord Yahweh.
15 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "Because the Philistines have taken revenge, and have taken vengeance with contempt of soul to destroy with perpetual hostility,"
16 therefore the Lord Yahweh says, "Behold, I will stretch out my hand on the Philistines, and I will cut off the Cherethites, and destroy the remnant of the sea coast.
17 I will execute great vengeance on them with wrathful rebukes. Then they will know that I am Yahweh, when I lay my vengeance on them." ' "

26

1 In the eleventh year, in the first of the month, Yahweh's word came to me, saying,

2 "Son of man, because Tyre has said
against Jerusalem, 'Aha! She is broken!
She who was the gateway of the peoples
has been returned to me. I will be
replenished, now that she is laid waste;'
3 therefore the Lord Yahweh says,
'Behold, I am against you, Tyre, and will
cause many nations to come up against
you, as the sea causes its waves to come
up.
4 They will destroy the walls of Tyre,
and break down her towers. I will also
scrape her dust from her, and make her a
bare rock.
5 She will be a place for the spreading of
nets in the middle of the sea; for I have
spoken it,' says the Lord Yahweh. 'She will
become plunder for the nations.
6 Her daughters who are in the field will
be slain with the sword. Then they will
know that I am Yahweh.'

7 "For the Lord Yahweh says: 'Behold, I
will bring on Tyre Nebuchadnezzar king
of Babylon, king of kings, from the north,
with horses, with chariots, with
horsemen, and an army with many
people.
8 He will kill your daughters in the field
with the sword. He will make forts against
you, cast up a mound against you, and
raise up the buckler against you.
9 He will set his battering engines
against your walls, and with his axes he
will break down your towers.
10 By reason of the abundance of his
horses, their dust will cover you. Your
walls will shake at the noise of the
horsemen, of the wagons, and of the
chariots, when he enters into your gates,
as men enter into a city which is broken
open.
11 He will tread down all your streets
with the hoofs of his horses. He will kill
your people with the sword. The pillars of
your strength will go down to the ground.
12 They will make a plunder of your
riches and make a prey of your
merchandise. They will break down your
walls and destroy your pleasant houses.
They will lay your stones, your timber,
and your dust in the middle of the waters.
13 I will cause the noise of your songs to
cease. The sound of your harps won't be
heard any more.
14 I will make you a bare rock. You will
be a place for the spreading of nets. You
will be built no more; for I Yahweh have
spoken it,' says the Lord Yahweh.
15 "The Lord Yahweh says to Tyre:
'Won't the islands shake at the sound of
your fall, when the wounded groan, when
the slaughter is made within you?
16 Then all the princes of the sea will
come down from their thrones, and lay
aside their robes, and strip off their
embroidered garments. They will clothe
themselves with trembling. They will sit
on the ground, and will tremble every
moment, and be astonished at you.
17 They will take up a lamentation over
you, and tell you,
"How you are destroyed,
who were inhabited by seafaring
men,
the renowned city,
who was strong in the sea,
she and her inhabitants,
who caused their terror to be on all
who lived there!"
18 Now the islands will tremble in the day
of your fall.
Yes, the islands that are in the sea will
be dismayed at your departure.'
19 "For the Lord Yahweh says: 'When I
make you a desolate city, like the cities
that are not inhabited, when I bring up
the deep on you, and the great waters
cover you,
20 then I will bring you down with those
who descend into the pit, to the people of
old time, and will make you dwell in the
lower parts of the earth, in the places that
are desolate of old, with those who go
down to the pit, that you be not inhabited;
and I will set glory in the land of the living.
21 I will make you a terror, and you will
no more have any being. Though you are
sought for, yet you will never be found
again,' says the Lord Yahweh."

27

1 Yahweh's word came again to me,
saying,

2 “You, son of man, take up a
lamentation over Tyre;
3 and tell Tyre, ‘You who dwell at the
entry of the sea, who are the merchant of
the peoples to many islands, the Lord
Yahweh says:
“You, Tyre, have said,
‘I am perfect in beauty.’
4 Your borders are in the heart of the seas.
Your builders have perfected your
beauty.
5 They have made all your planks of
cypress trees from Senir.
They have taken a cedar from
Lebanon to make a mast for you.
6 They have made your oars of the oaks of
Bashan.
They have made your benches of
ivory inlaid in cypress wood from
the islands of Kittim.
7 Your sail was of fine linen with
embroidered work from Egypt,
that it might be to you for a banner.
Blue and purple from the islands of
Elishah was your awning.
8 The inhabitants of Sidon and Arvad were
your rowers.
Your wise men, Tyre, were in you.
They were your pilots.
9 The old men of Gebal
and its wise men were your repairers
of ship seams in you.
All the ships of the sea with their
mariners were in you
to deal in your merchandise.

10 “ ‘ “Persia, Lud, and Put were in your
army,
your men of war.
They hung the shield and helmet in you.
They showed your beauty.
11 The men of Arvad with your army were
on your walls all around,
and valiant men were in your towers.
They hung their shields on your walls all
around.
They have perfected your beauty.
12 “ ‘ “Tarshish was your merchant by
reason of the multitude of all kinds of
riches. They traded for your wares with
silver, iron, tin, and lead.
13 “ ‘ “Javan, Tubal, and Meshech were
your traders. They traded the persons of
men and vessels of bronze for your
merchandise.
14 “ ‘ “They of the house of Togarmah
traded for your wares with horses, war
horses, and mules.
15 “ ‘ “The men of Dedan traded with
you. Many islands were the market of
your hand. They brought you horns of
ivory and ebony in exchange.
16 “ ‘ “Syria was your merchant by
reason of the multitude of your
handiworks. They traded for your wares
with emeralds, purple, embroidered
work, fine linen, coral, and rubies.
17 “ ‘ “Judah and the land of Israel were
your traders. They traded wheat of
Minnith, confections, honey, oil, and balm
for your merchandise.
18 “ ‘ “Damascus was your merchant for
the multitude of your handiworks by
reason of the multitude of all kinds of
riches, with the wine of Helbon, and white
wool.
19 “ ‘ “Vedan and Javan traded with yarn
for your wares; wrought iron, cassia, and
calamus were among your merchandise.
20 “ ‘ “Dedan was your merchant in
precious saddle blankets for riding.
21 “ ‘ “Arabia and all the princes of
Kedar were your favorite dealers in
lambs, rams, and goats. In these, they
were your merchants.
22 “ ‘ “The traders of Sheba and Raamah
were your traders. They traded for your
wares with the best of all spices, all
precious stones, and gold.
23 “ ‘ “Haran, Canneh, Eden, the traders
of Sheba, Asshur and Chilmad, were your
traders.
24 These were your traders in choice
wares, in wrappings of blue and
embroidered work, and in cedar chests of
rich clothing bound with cords, among
your merchandise.
25 “ ‘ “The ships of Tarshish were your
caravans for your merchandise.
You were replenished
and made very glorious in the heart
of the seas.

26 Your rowers have brought you into great waters.
The east wind has broken you in the heart of the seas.
27 Your riches, your wares, your merchandise,
your mariners, your pilots, your repairers of ship seams,
the dealers in your merchandise,
and all your men of war who are in you,
with all your company which is among you,
will fall into the heart of the seas in the day of your ruin.
28 At the sound of the cry of your pilots,
the pasture lands will shake.
29 All who handle the oars,
the mariners and all the pilots of the sea,
will come down from their ships.
They will stand on the land,
30 and will cause their voice to be heard over you,
and will cry bitterly.
They will cast up dust on their heads.
They will wallow in the ashes.
31 They will make themselves bald for you,
and clothe themselves with sackcloth.
They will weep for you in bitterness of soul,
with bitter mourning.
32 In their wailing they will take up a lamentation for you,
and lament over you, saying,
'Who is there like Tyre,
like her who is brought to silence in the middle of the sea?'
33 When your wares came from the seas,
you filled many peoples.
You enriched the kings of the earth
with the multitude of your riches and of your merchandise.
34 In the time that you were broken by the seas,
in the depths of the waters,
your merchandise and all your company fell within you.
35 All the inhabitants of the islands are astonished at you,
and their kings are horribly afraid.
They are troubled in their face.
36 The merchants among the peoples hiss at you.
You have come to a terrible end,
and you will be no more." ' "

28

1 Yahweh's word came again to me, saying,
2 "Son of man, tell the prince of Tyre,
'The Lord Yahweh says:
"Because your heart is lifted up,
and you have said, 'I am a god,
I sit in the seat of God,
in the middle of the seas;'
yet you are man,
and no god,
though you set your heart as the heart of a god—
3 behold, you are wiser than Daniel.
There is no secret that is hidden from you.
4 By your wisdom and by your understanding you have gotten yourself riches,
and have gotten gold and silver into your treasuries.
5 By your great wisdom
and by your trading you have increased your riches,
and your heart is lifted up because of your riches—"
6 " 'therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
"Because you have set your heart as the heart of God,
7 therefore, behold, I will bring strangers on you,
the terrible of the nations.
They will draw their swords against the beauty of your wisdom.
They will defile your brightness.
8 They will bring you down to the pit.
You will die the death of those who are slain
in the heart of the seas.
9 Will you yet say before him who kills you, 'I am God'?
But you are man, and not God,
in the hand of him who wounds you.
10 You will die the death of the uncircumcised
by the hand of strangers;

for I have spoken it," says the Lord
Yahweh.' "

11 Moreover Yahweh's word came to
me, saying,
12 "Son of man, take up a lamentation
over the king of Tyre, and tell him, 'The
Lord Yahweh says:
"You were the seal of full measure,
full of wisdom,
and perfect in beauty.
13 You were in Eden,
the garden of God.
Every precious stone adorned you:
ruby, topaz, emerald,
chrysolite, onyx, jasper,
sapphire,† turquoise, and beryl.
Gold work of tambourines
and of pipes was in you.
They were prepared in the day that
you were created.
14 You were the anointed cherub who
covers.
Then I set you up on the holy
mountain of God.
You have walked up and down in the
middle of the stones of fire.
15 You were perfect in your ways from the
day that you were created,
until unrighteousness was found in
you.
16 By the abundance of your commerce,
your insides were filled with
violence,
and you have sinned.
Therefore I have cast you as profane out
of God's mountain.
I have destroyed you, covering
cherub,
from the middle of the stones of fire.
17 Your heart was lifted up because of
your beauty.
You have corrupted your wisdom by
reason of your splendor.
I have cast you to the ground.
I have laid you before kings,
that they may see you.
18 By the multitude of your iniquities,
in the unrighteousness of your
commerce,
you have profaned your sanctuaries.
Therefore I have brought out a fire from
the middle of you.
It has devoured you.
I have turned you to ashes on the earth
in the sight of all those who see you.
19 All those who know you among the
peoples will be astonished at you.
You have become a terror,
and you will exist no more." ' "

20 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
21 "Son of man, set your face toward
Sidon, and prophesy against it,
22 and say, 'The Lord Yahweh says:
"Behold, I am against you, Sidon.
I will be glorified among you.
Then they will know that I am Yahweh,
when I have executed judgments in
her,
and am sanctified in her.
23 For I will send pestilence into her,
and blood into her streets.
The wounded will fall within her,
with the sword on her on every side.
Then they will know that I am
Yahweh.
24 " ' "There will no longer be a pricking
brier to the house of Israel, nor a hurting
thorn of any that are around them that
scorned them. Then they will know that I
am the Lord Yahweh."
25 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "When I
have gathered the house of Israel from
the peoples among whom they are
scattered, and am shown as holy among
them in the sight of the nations, then they
will dwell in their own land which I gave
to my servant Jacob.
26 They will dwell in it securely. Yes,
they will build houses, plant vineyards,
and will dwell securely when I have
executed judgments on all those around
them who have treated them with
contempt. Then they will know that I am
Yahweh their God." ' "

29

1 In the tenth year, in the tenth month,
on the twelfth day of the month, Yahweh's
word came to me, saying,

† **28:13** or, lapis lazuli

2 “Son of man, set your face against
Pharaoh king of Egypt, and prophesy
against him and against all Egypt.
3 Speak and say, ‘The Lord Yahweh says:
“Behold, I am against you, Pharaoh king of
Egypt,
the great monster that lies in the
middle of his rivers,
that has said, ‘My river is my own,
and I have made it for myself.’
4 I will put hooks in your jaws,
and I will make the fish of your rivers
stick to your scales.
I will bring you up out of the middle of
your rivers,
with all the fish of your rivers which
stick to your scales.
5 I’ll cast you out into the wilderness,
you and all the fish of your rivers.
You’ll fall on the open field.
You won’t be brought together or
gathered.
I have given you for food to the animals of
the earth
and to the birds of the sky.
6 “ ‘ “All the inhabitants of Egypt will
know that I am Yahweh, because they
have been a staff of reed to the house of
Israel.
7 When they took hold of you by your
hand, you broke and tore all their
shoulders. When they leaned on you, you
broke and paralyzed all of their thighs.”
8 “ ‘Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
“Behold, I will bring a sword on you, and
will cut off man and animal from you.
9 The land of Egypt will be a desolation
and a waste. Then they will know that I
am Yahweh.
“ ‘ “Because he has said, ‘The river is
mine, and I have made it,’
10 therefore, behold, I am against you
and against your rivers. I will make the
land of Egypt an utter waste and
desolation, from the tower of Seveneh
even to the border of Ethiopia.
11 No foot of man will pass through it,
nor will any animal foot pass through it. It
won’t be inhabited for forty years.
12 I will make the land of Egypt a
desolation in the middle of the countries
that are desolate. Her cities among the
cities that are laid waste will be a
desolation forty years. I will scatter the
Egyptians among the nations, and will
disperse them through the countries.”
13 “ ‘For the Lord Yahweh says: “At the
end of forty years I will gather the
Egyptians from the peoples where they
were scattered.
14 I will reverse the captivity of Egypt,
and will cause them to return into the
land of Pathros, into the land of their
birth. There they will be a lowly kingdom.
15 It will be the lowest of the kingdoms.
It won’t lift itself up above the nations any
more. I will diminish them so that they
will no longer rule over the nations.
16 It will no longer be the confidence of
the house of Israel, bringing iniquity to
memory, when they turn to look after
them. Then they will know that I am the
Lord Yahweh.” ’ ”

17 It came to pass in the twenty-seventh
year, in the first month, in the first day of
the month, Yahweh’s word came to me,
saying,
18 “Son of man, Nebuchadnezzar king of
Babylon caused his army to serve a great
service against Tyre. Every head was
made bald, and every shoulder was worn;
yet he had no wages, nor did his army,
from Tyre, for the service that he had
served against it.
19 Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
‘Behold, I will give the land of Egypt to
Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon. He will
carry off her multitude, take her plunder,
and take her prey. That will be the wages
for his army.
20 I have given him the land of Egypt as
his payment for which he served, because
they worked for me,’ says the Lord
Yahweh.
21 “In that day I will cause a horn to
sprout for the house of Israel, and I will
open your mouth among them. Then they
will know that I am Yahweh.”

30

1 Yahweh’s word came again to me,
saying,

2 “Son of man, prophesy, and say, ‘The
Lord Yahweh says:
“Wail, ‘Alas for the day!’
3 For the day is near,
even Yahweh’s day is near.
It will be a day of clouds,
a time of the nations.
4 A sword will come on Egypt,
and anguish will be in Ethiopia,
when the slain fall in Egypt.
They take away her multitude,
and her foundations are broken
down.
5 “ ‘ “Ethiopia, Put, Lud, all the mixed
people, Cub, and the children of the land
that is allied with them, will fall with them
by the sword.”
6 “ ‘Yahweh says:
“They also who uphold Egypt will fall.
The pride of her power will come
down.
They will fall by the sword in it from the
tower of Seveneh,”
says the Lord Yahweh.
7 “They will be desolate in the middle of
the countries that are desolate.
Her cities will be among the cities that
are wasted.
8 They will know that I am Yahweh
when I have set a fire in Egypt,
and all her helpers are destroyed.
9 “ ‘ “In that day messengers will go out
from before me in ships to make the
careless Ethiopians afraid. There will be
anguish on them, as in the day of Egypt;
for, behold, it comes.”
10 “ ‘The Lord Yahweh says:
“I will also make the multitude of Egypt to
cease,
by the hand of Nebuchadnezzar king
of Babylon.
11 He and his people with him,
the terrible of the nations,
will be brought in to destroy the land.
They will draw their swords against
Egypt,
and fill the land with the slain.
12 I will make the rivers dry,
and will sell the land into the hand of
evil men.
I will make the land desolate,
and all that is therein,
by the hand of foreigners.
I, Yahweh, have spoken it.”
13 “ ‘The Lord Yahweh says:
“I will also destroy the idols,
and I will cause the images to cease
from Memphis.
There will be no more a prince from the
land of Egypt.
I will put a fear in the land of Egypt.
14 I will make Pathros desolate,
and will set a fire in Zoan,
and will execute judgments on No.
15 I will pour my wrath on Sin,
the stronghold of Egypt.
I will cut off the multitude of No.
16 I will set a fire in Egypt
Sin will be in great anguish.
No will be broken up.
Memphis will have adversaries in the
daytime.
17 The young men of Aven and of Pibeseth
will fall by the sword.
They will go into captivity.
18 At Tehaphnehes also the day will
withdraw itself,
when I break the yokes of Egypt there.
The pride of her power will cease in her.
As for her, a cloud will cover her,
and her daughters will go into
captivity.
19 Thus I will execute judgments on Egypt.
Then they will know that I am
Yahweh.” ’ ”

20 In the eleventh year, in the first
month, in the seventh day of the month,
Yahweh’s word came to me, saying,
21 “Son of man, I have broken the arm of
Pharaoh king of Egypt. Behold, it has not
been bound up, to apply medicines, to put
a bandage to bind it, that it may become
strong to hold the sword.
22 Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
‘Behold, I am against Pharaoh king of
Egypt, and will break his arms, the strong
arm, and that which was broken. I will
cause the sword to fall out of his hand.
23 I will scatter the Egyptians among the
nations, and will disperse them through
the countries.

24 I will strengthen the arms of the king
of Babylon, and put my sword in his hand;
but I will break the arms of Pharaoh, and
he will groan before the king of Babylon
with the groaning of a mortally wounded
man.
25 I will hold up the arms of the king of
Babylon, but the arms of Pharaoh will fall
down. Then they will know that I am
Yahweh when I put my sword into the
hand of the king of Babylon, and he
stretches it out on the land of Egypt.
26 I will scatter the Egyptians among the
nations and disperse them through the
countries. Then they will know that I am
Yahweh.' "

31

1 In the eleventh year, in the third
month, in the first day of the month,
Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
2 "Son of man, tell Pharaoh king of Egypt
and his multitude:
'Whom are you like in your greatness?
3 Behold, the Assyrian was a cedar in
Lebanon
with beautiful branches,
and with a forest-like shade,
of high stature;
and its top was among the thick
boughs.
4 The waters nourished it.
The deep made it to grow.
Its rivers ran all around its plantation.
It sent out its channels to all the trees
of the field.
5 Therefore its stature was exalted above
all the trees of the field;
and its boughs were multiplied.
Its branches became long by reason of
many waters,
when it spread them out.
6 All the birds of the sky made their nests
in its boughs.
Under its branches, all the animals of
the field gave birth to their young.
All great nations lived under its
shadow.
7 Thus it was beautiful in its greatness,
in the length of its branches;
for its root was by many waters.
8 The cedars in the garden of God could
not hide it.
The cypress trees were not like its
branches.
The pine trees were not like its branches;
nor was any tree in the garden of God
like it in its beauty.
9 I made it beautiful by the multitude of its
branches,
so that all the trees of Eden,
that were in the garden of God,
envied it.'
10 "Therefore thus said the Lord
Yahweh: 'Because he is exalted in stature,
and he has set his top among the thick
branches, and his heart is lifted up in his
height,
11 I will deliver him into the hand of the
mighty one of the nations. He will surely
deal with him. I have driven him out for
his wickedness.
12 Foreigners, the tyrants of the nations,
have cut him off and have left him. His
branches have fallen on the mountains
and in all the valleys, and his boughs are
broken by all the watercourses of the
land. All the peoples of the earth have
gone down from his shadow and have left
him.
13 All the birds of the sky will dwell on
his ruin, and all the animals of the field
will be on his branches,
14 to the end that none of all the trees by
the waters exalt themselves in their
stature, and don't set their top among the
thick boughs. Their mighty ones don't
stand up on their height, even all who
drink water; for they are all delivered to
death, to the lower parts of the earth,
among the children of men, with those
who go down to the pit.'
15 "The Lord Yahweh says: 'In the day
when he went down to Sheol,† I caused a
mourning. I covered the deep for him,
and I restrained its rivers. The great
waters were stopped. I caused Lebanon to
mourn for him, and all the trees of the
field fainted for him.
16 I made the nations to shake at the
sound of his fall, when I cast him down to
Sheol‡ with those who descend into the
pit. All the trees of Eden, the choice and

† **31:15** Sheol is the place of the dead. ‡ **31:16** Sheol is the place of the dead.

best of Lebanon, all that drink water,
were comforted in the lower parts of the earth.
17 They also went down into Sheol with him to those who are slain by the sword;
yes, those who were his arm, who lived under his shadow in the middle of the nations.
18 “ ‘To whom are you thus like in glory and in greatness among the trees of Eden?
Yet you will be brought down with the trees of Eden to the lower parts of the earth. You will lie in the middle of the uncircumcised, with those who are slain by the sword.
“ ‘This is Pharaoh and all his multitude,’ says the Lord Yahweh.”

32

1 In the twelfth year, in the twelfth month, in the first day of the month,
Yahweh’s word came to me, saying,
2 “Son of man, take up a lamentation over Pharaoh king of Egypt, and tell him,
‘You were likened to a young lion of the nations;
yet you are as a monster in the seas.
You broke out with your rivers,
and troubled the waters with your feet,
and fouled their rivers.’ ”
3 The Lord Yahweh says:
“I will spread out my net on you with a company of many peoples.
They will bring you up in my net.
4 I will leave you on the land.
I will cast you out on the open field,
and will cause all the birds of the sky to settle on you.
I will satisfy the animals of the whole earth with you.
5 I will lay your flesh on the mountains,
and fill the valleys with your height.
6 I will also water the land in which you swim with your blood,
even to the mountains.
The watercourses will be full of you.
7 When I extinguish you, I will cover the heavens
and make its stars dark.
I will cover the sun with a cloud,
and the moon won’t give its light.
8 I will make all the bright lights of the sky dark over you,
and set darkness on your land,” says the Lord Yahweh.
9 “I will also trouble the hearts of many peoples,
when I bring your destruction among the nations,
into the countries which you have not known.
10 Yes, I will make many peoples amazed at you,
and their kings will be horribly afraid for you,
when I brandish my sword before them.
They will tremble at every moment,
every man for his own life,
in the day of your fall.”
11 For the Lord Yahweh says:
“The sword of the king of Babylon will come on you.
12 I will cause your multitude to fall by the swords of the mighty.
They are all the ruthless of the nations.
They will bring the pride of Egypt to nothing,
and all its multitude will be destroyed.
13 I will destroy also all its animals from beside many waters.
The foot of man won’t trouble them any more,
nor will the hoofs of animals trouble them.
14 Then I will make their waters clear,
and cause their rivers to run like oil,” says the Lord Yahweh.
15 “When I make the land of Egypt desolate and waste,
a land destitute of that of which it was full,
when I strike all those who dwell therein,
then they will know that I am Yahweh.
16 “ ‘ “This is the lamentation with which they will lament. The daughters of the nations will lament with this. They will lament with it over Egypt, and over all her multitude,” says the Lord Yahweh.’ ”

17 Also in the twelfth year, in the
fifteenth day of the month, Yahweh's
word came to me, saying,
18 "Son of man, wail for the multitude of
Egypt, and cast them down, even her and
the daughters of the famous nations, to
the lower parts of the earth, with those
who go down into the pit.
19 Whom do you pass in beauty? Go
down, and be laid with the
uncircumcised.
20 They will fall among those who are
slain by the sword. She is delivered to the
sword. Draw her away with all her
multitudes.
21 The strong among the mighty will
speak to him out of the middle of Sheol†
with those who help him. They have gone
down. The uncircumcised lie still, slain by
the sword.
22 "Asshur is there with all her
company. Her graves are all around her.
All of them are slain, fallen by the sword,
23 whose graves are set in the uttermost
parts of the pit, and her company is
around her grave, all of them slain, fallen
by the sword, who caused terror in the
land of the living.
24 "There is Elam and all her multitude
around her grave; all of them slain, fallen
by the sword, who have gone down
uncircumcised into the lower parts of the
earth, who caused their terror in the land
of the living, and have borne their shame
with those who go down to the pit.
25 They have made Elam a bed among
the slain with all her multitude. Her
graves are around her, all of them
uncircumcised, slain by the sword; for
their terror was caused in the land of the
living, and they have borne their shame
with those who go down to the pit. He is
put among those who are slain.
26 "There is Meshech, Tubal, and all
their multitude. Their graves are around
them, all of them uncircumcised, slain by
the sword; for they caused their terror in
the land of the living.
27 They will not lie with the mighty who
are fallen of the uncircumcised, who have
gone down to Sheol with their weapons of
war and have laid their swords under
their heads. Their iniquities are on their
bones; for they were the terror of the
mighty in the land of the living.
28 "But you will be broken among the
uncircumcised, and will lie with those
who are slain by the sword.
29 "There is Edom, her kings, and all her
princes, who in their might are laid with
those who are slain by the sword. They
will lie with the uncircumcised, and with
those who go down to the pit.
30 "There are the princes of the north,
all of them, and all the Sidonians, who
have gone down with the slain. They are
put to shame in the terror which they
caused by their might. They lie
uncircumcised with those who are slain
by the sword, and bear their shame with
those who go down to the pit.
31 "Pharaoh will see them and will be
comforted over all his multitude, even
Pharaoh and all his army, slain by the
sword," says the Lord Yahweh.
32 "For I have put his terror in the land
of the living. He will be laid among the
uncircumcised, with those who are slain
by the sword, even Pharaoh and all his
multitude," says the Lord Yahweh.

33

1 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
2 "Son of man, speak to the children of
your people, and tell them, 'When I bring
the sword on a land, and the people of the
land take a man from among them, and
set him for their watchman,
3 if, when he sees the sword come on the
land, he blows the trumpet and warns the
people,
4 then whoever hears the sound of the
trumpet and doesn't heed the warning, if
the sword comes and takes him away, his
blood will be on his own head.
5 He heard the sound of the trumpet and
didn't take warning. His blood will be on
him; whereas if he had heeded the
warning, he would have delivered his
soul.
6 But if the watchman sees the sword
come and doesn't blow the trumpet, and

† **32:21** Sheol is the place of the dead.

the people aren't warned, and the sword comes and takes any person from among them, he is taken away in his iniquity, but his blood I will require at the watchman's hand.'

7 "So you, son of man, I have set you a watchman to the house of Israel. Therefore hear the word from my mouth, and give them warnings from me.

8 When I tell the wicked, 'O wicked man, you will surely die,' and you don't speak to warn the wicked from his way, that wicked man will die in his iniquity, but I will require his blood at your hand.

9 Nevertheless, if you warn the wicked of his way to turn from it, and he doesn't turn from his way; he will die in his iniquity, but you have delivered your soul.

10 "You, son of man, tell the house of Israel: 'You say this, "Our transgressions and our sins are on us, and we pine away in them. How then can we live?" '

11 Tell them, ' "As I live," says the Lord Yahweh, "I have no pleasure in the death of the wicked, but that the wicked turn from his way and live. Turn, turn from your evil ways! For why will you die, house of Israel?" '

12 "You, son of man, tell the children of your people, 'The righteousness of the righteous will not deliver him in the day of his disobedience. And as for the wickedness of the wicked, he will not fall by it in the day that he turns from his wickedness; neither will he who is righteous be able to live by it in the day that he sins.

13 When I tell the righteous that he will surely live, if he trusts in his righteousness and commits iniquity, none of his righteous deeds will be remembered; but he will die in his iniquity that he has committed.

14 Again, when I say to the wicked, "You will surely die," if he turns from his sin and does that which is lawful and right,

15 if the wicked restore the pledge, give again that which he had taken by robbery, walk in the statutes of life, committing no iniquity, he will surely live. He will not die.

16 None of his sins that he has committed will be remembered against him. He has done that which is lawful and right. He will surely live.

17 " 'Yet the children of your people say, "The way of the Lord is not fair;" but as for them, their way is not fair.

18 When the righteous turns from his righteousness and commits iniquity, he will even die therein.

19 When the wicked turns from his wickedness and does that which is lawful and right, he will live by it.

20 Yet you say, "The way of the Lord is not fair." House of Israel, I will judge every one of you after his ways.' "

21 In the twelfth year of our captivity, in the tenth month, in the fifth day of the month, one who had escaped out of Jerusalem came to me, saying, "The city has been defeated!"

22 Now Yahweh's hand had been on me in the evening, before he who had escaped came; and he had opened my mouth until he came to me in the morning; and my mouth was opened, and I was no longer mute.

23 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,

24 "Son of man, those who inhabit the waste places in the land of Israel speak, saying, 'Abraham was one, and he inherited the land; but we are many. The land is given us for inheritance.'

25 Therefore tell them, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "You eat with the blood, and lift up your eyes to your idols, and shed blood. So should you possess the land?

26 You stand on your sword, you work abomination, and every one of you defiles his neighbor's wife. So should you possess the land?" '

27 "You shall tell them, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "As I live, surely those who are in the waste places will fall by the sword. I will give whoever is in the open field to the animals to be devoured, and those who are in the strongholds and in the caves will die of the pestilence.

28 I will make the land a desolation and an astonishment. The pride of her power

will cease. The mountains of Israel will be desolate, so that no one will pass through.
29 Then they will know that I am Yahweh, when I have made the land a desolation and an astonishment because of all their abominations which they have committed." '
30 "As for you, son of man, the children of your people talk about you by the walls and in the doors of the houses, and speak to one another, everyone to his brother, saying, 'Please come and hear what the word is that comes out from Yahweh.'
31 They come to you as the people come, and they sit before you as my people, and they hear your words, but don't do them; for with their mouth they show much love, but their heart goes after their gain.
32 Behold, you are to them as a very lovely song of one who has a pleasant voice, and can play well on an instrument; for they hear your words, but they don't do them.
33 "When this comes to pass—behold, it comes—then they will know that a prophet has been among them."

34

1 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
2 "Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel. Prophesy, and tell them, even the shepherds, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "Woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves! Shouldn't the shepherds feed the sheep?
3 You eat the fat. You clothe yourself with the wool. You kill the fatlings, but you don't feed the sheep.
4 You haven't strengthened the diseased. You haven't healed that which was sick. You haven't bound up that which was broken. You haven't brought back that which was driven away. You haven't sought that which was lost, but you have ruled over them with force and with rigor.
5 They were scattered, because there was no shepherd. They became food to all the animals of the field, and were scattered.
6 My sheep wandered through all the mountains and on every high hill. Yes, my sheep were scattered on all the surface of the earth. There was no one who searched or sought."

7 " 'Therefore, you shepherds, hear Yahweh's word:
8 "As I live," says the Lord Yahweh, "surely because my sheep became a prey, and my sheep became food to all the animals of the field, because there was no shepherd, and my shepherds didn't search for my sheep, but the shepherds fed themselves, and didn't feed my sheep,
9 therefore, you shepherds, hear Yahweh's word!"
10 The Lord Yahweh says: "Behold, I am against the shepherds. I will require my sheep at their hand, and cause them to cease from feeding the sheep. The shepherds won't feed themselves any more. I will deliver my sheep from their mouth, that they may not be food for them."

11 " 'For the Lord Yahweh says: "Behold, I myself, even I, will search for my sheep, and will seek them out.
12 As a shepherd seeks out his flock in the day that he is among his sheep that are scattered abroad, so I will seek out my sheep. I will deliver them out of all places where they have been scattered in the cloudy and dark day.
13 I will bring them out from the peoples, and gather them from the countries, and will bring them into their own land. I will feed them on the mountains of Israel, by the watercourses, and in all the inhabited places of the country.
14 I will feed them with good pasture, and their fold will be on the mountains of the height of Israel. There they will lie down in a good fold. They will feed on rich pasture on the mountains of Israel.
15 I myself will be the shepherd of my sheep, and I will cause them to lie down," says the Lord Yahweh.
16 "I will seek that which was lost, and will bring back that which was driven away, and will bind up that which was broken, and will strengthen that which was sick; but I will destroy the fat and the strong. I will feed them in justice." '

17 “As for you, O my flock, the Lord
Yahweh says: ‘Behold, I judge between
sheep and sheep, the rams and the male
goats.
18 Does it seem a small thing to you to
have fed on the good pasture, but you
must tread down with your feet the
residue of your pasture? And to have
drunk of the clear waters, but must you
foul the residue with your feet?
19 As for my sheep, they eat that which
you have trodden with your feet, and they
drink that which you have fouled with
your feet.’
20 “Therefore the Lord Yahweh says to
them: ‘Behold, I, even I, will judge
between the fat sheep and the lean sheep.
21 Because you thrust with side and with
shoulder, and push all the diseased with
your horns, until you have scattered them
abroad,
22 therefore I will save my flock, and
they will no more be a prey. I will judge
between sheep and sheep.
23 I will set up one shepherd over them,
and he will feed them, even my servant
David. He will feed them, and he will be
their shepherd.
24 I, Yahweh, will be their God, and my
servant David prince among them. I,
Yahweh, have spoken it.
25 “ ‘I will make with them a covenant of
peace, and will cause evil animals to cease
out of the land. They will dwell securely
in the wilderness and sleep in the woods.
26 I will make them and the places
around my hill a blessing. I will cause the
shower to come down in its season. There
will be showers of blessing.
27 The tree of the field will yield its fruit,
and the earth will yield its increase, and
they will be secure in their land. Then
they will know that I am Yahweh, when I
have broken the bars of their yoke, and
have delivered them out of the hand of
those who made slaves of them.
28 They will no more be a prey to the
nations, neither will the animals of the
earth devour them; but they will dwell
securely, and no one will make them
afraid.
29 I will raise up to them a plantation for
renown, and they will no more be
consumed with famine in the land, and
not bear the shame of the nations any
more.
30 They will know that I, Yahweh, their
God am with them, and that they, the
house of Israel, are my people, says the
Lord Yahweh.
31 You my sheep, the sheep of my
pasture, are men, and I am your God,’ says
the Lord Yahweh.”

35

1 Moreover Yahweh’s word came to me,
saying,
2 “Son of man, set your face against
Mount Seir, and prophesy against it,
3 and tell it, ‘The Lord Yahweh says:
“Behold, I am against you, Mount Seir,
and I will stretch out my hand against
you. I will make you a desolation and an
astonishment.
4 I will lay your cities waste, and you
will be desolate. Then you will know that I
am Yahweh.
5 “ ‘ “Because you have had a perpetual
hostility, and have given over the children
of Israel to the power of the sword in the
time of their calamity, in the time of the
iniquity of the end,
6 therefore, as I live,” says the Lord
Yahweh, “I will prepare you for blood,
and blood will pursue you. Since you have
not hated blood, therefore blood will
pursue you.
7 Thus I will make Mount Seir an
astonishment and a desolation. I will cut
off from it him who passes through and
him who returns.
8 I will fill its mountains with its slain.
The slain with the sword will fall in your
hills and in your valleys and in all your
watercourses.
9 I will make you a perpetual desolation,
and your cities will not be inhabited.
Then you will know that I am Yahweh.
10 “ ‘ “Because you have said, ‘These two
nations and these two countries will be
mine, and we will possess it,’ although
Yahweh was there,
11 therefore, as I live,” says the Lord
Yahweh, “I will do according to your

anger, and according to your envy which you have shown out of your hatred against them; and I will make myself known among them when I judge you.
12 You will know that I, Yahweh, have heard all your insults which you have spoken against the mountains of Israel, saying, 'They have been laid desolate. They have been given to us to devour.'
13 You have magnified yourselves against me with your mouth, and have multiplied your words against me. I have heard it."
14 The Lord Yahweh says: "When the whole earth rejoices, I will make you desolate.
15 As you rejoiced over the inheritance of the house of Israel because it was desolate, so I will do to you. You will be desolate, Mount Seir, and all Edom, even all of it. Then they will know that I am Yahweh.' "

36

1 You, son of man, prophesy to the mountains of Israel, and say, "You mountains of Israel, hear Yahweh's word.
2 The Lord Yahweh says: 'Because the enemy has said against you, "Aha!" and, "The ancient high places are ours in possession!" '
3 therefore prophesy, and say, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "Because, even because they have made you desolate, and swallowed you up on every side, that you might be a possession to the residue of the nations, and you are taken up in the lips of talkers, and the evil report of the people;"
4 therefore, you mountains of Israel, hear the word of the Lord Yahweh: The Lord Yahweh says to the mountains and to the hills, to the watercourses and to the valleys, to the desolate wastes and to the cities that are forsaken, which have become a prey and derision to the residue of the nations that are all around;
5 therefore the Lord Yahweh says: "Surely in the fire of my jealousy I have spoken against the residue of the nations, and against all Edom, that have appointed my land to themselves for a possession with the joy of all their heart, with despite of soul, to cast it out for a prey." '
6 Therefore prophesy concerning the land of Israel, and tell the mountains, the hills, the watercourses and the valleys, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "Behold, I have spoken in my jealousy and in my wrath, because you have borne the shame of the nations."
7 Therefore the Lord Yahweh says: "I have sworn, 'Surely the nations that are around you will bear their shame.'
8 " ' "But you, mountains of Israel, you shall shoot out your branches and yield your fruit to my people Israel; for they are at hand to come.
9 For, behold, I am for you, and I will come to you, and you will be tilled and sown.
10 I will multiply men on you, all the house of Israel, even all of it. The cities will be inhabited and the waste places will be built.
11 I will multiply man and animal on you. They will increase and be fruitful. I will cause you to be inhabited as you were before, and you will do better than at your beginnings. Then you will know that I am Yahweh.
12 Yes, I will cause men to walk on you, even my people Israel. They will possess you, and you will be their inheritance, and you will never again bereave them of their children."
13 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "Because they say to you, 'You are a devourer of men, and have been a bereaver of your nation;'
14 therefore you shall devour men no more, and not bereave your nation any more," says the Lord Yahweh.
15 "I won't let you hear the shame of the nations any more. You won't bear the reproach of the peoples any more, and you won't cause your nation to stumble any more," says the Lord Yahweh.' "
16 Moreover Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
17 "Son of man, when the house of Israel lived in their own land, they defiled it by their ways and by their deeds. Their way

before me was as the uncleanness of a
woman in her impurity.
18 Therefore I poured out my wrath on
them for the blood which they had poured
out on the land, and because they had
defiled it with their idols.
19 I scattered them among the nations,
and they were dispersed through the
countries. I judged them according to
their way and according to their deeds.
20 When they came to the nations where
they went, they profaned my holy name,
in that men said of them, 'These are
Yahweh's people, and have left his land.'
21 But I had respect for my holy name,
which the house of Israel had profaned
among the nations where they went.
22 "Therefore tell the house of Israel,
'The Lord Yahweh says: "I don't do this for
your sake, house of Israel, but for my holy
name, which you have profaned among
the nations where you went.
23 I will sanctify my great name, which
has been profaned among the nations,
which you have profaned among them.
Then the nations will know that I am
Yahweh," says the Lord Yahweh, "when I
am proven holy in you before their eyes.
24 " ' "For I will take you from among the
nations and gather you out of all the
countries, and will bring you into your
own land.
25 I will sprinkle clean water on you, and
you will be clean. I will cleanse you from
all your filthiness and from all your idols.
26 I will also give you a new heart, and I
will put a new spirit within you. I will take
away the stony heart out of your flesh,
and I will give you a heart of flesh.
27 I will put my Spirit within you, and
cause you to walk in my statutes. You will
keep my ordinances and do them.
28 You will dwell in the land that I gave
to your fathers. You will be my people,
and I will be your God.
29 I will save you from all your
uncleanness. I will call for the grain and
will multiply it, and lay no famine on you.
30 I will multiply the fruit of the tree and
the increase of the field, that you may
receive no more the reproach of famine
among the nations.
31 " ' "Then you will remember your evil
ways, and your deeds that were not good;
and you will loathe yourselves in your
own sight for your iniquities and for your
abominations.
32 I don't do this for your sake," says the
Lord Yahweh. "Let it be known to you. Be
ashamed and confounded for your ways,
house of Israel."
33 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "In the day
that I cleanse you from all your iniquities,
I will cause the cities to be inhabited and
the waste places will be built.
34 The land that was desolate will be
tilled instead of being a desolation in the
sight of all who passed by.
35 They will say, 'This land that was
desolate has become like the garden of
Eden. The waste, desolate, and ruined
cities are fortified and inhabited.'
36 Then the nations that are left around
you will know that I, Yahweh, have built
the ruined places and planted that which
was desolate. I, Yahweh, have spoken it,
and I will do it."
37 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "For this,
moreover, I will be inquired of by the
house of Israel, to do it for them: I will
increase them with men like a flock.
38 As the flock for sacrifice, as the flock
of Jerusalem in her appointed feasts, so
the waste cities will be filled with flocks of
men. Then they will know that I am
Yahweh.' "

37

1 Yahweh's hand was on me, and he
brought me out in Yahweh's Spirit, and set
me down in the middle of the valley; and
it was full of bones.
2 He caused me to pass by them all
around; and behold, there were very
many in the open valley, and behold, they
were very dry.
3 He said to me, "Son of man, can these
bones live?"
I answered, "Lord Yahweh, you know."
4 Again he said to me, "Prophesy over
these bones, and tell them, 'You dry bones,
hear Yahweh's word.

5 The Lord Yahweh says to these bones:
“Behold, I will cause breath to enter into
you, and you will live.
6 I will lay sinews on you, and will bring
up flesh on you, and cover you with skin,
and put breath in you, and you will live.
Then you will know that I am Yahweh.” ’ ”
7 So I prophesied as I was commanded.
As I prophesied, there was a noise, and
behold, there was an earthquake. Then
the bones came together, bone to its bone.
8 I saw, and, behold, there were sinews
on them, and flesh came up, and skin
covered them above; but there was no
breath in them.
9 Then he said to me, “Prophesy to the
wind, prophesy, son of man, and tell the
wind, ‘The Lord Yahweh says: “Come
from the four winds, breath, and breathe
on these slain, that they may live.” ’ ”
10 So I prophesied as he commanded
me, and the breath came into them, and
they lived, and stood up on their feet, an
exceedingly great army.
11 Then he said to me, “Son of man,
these bones are the whole house of Israel.
Behold, they say, ‘Our bones are dried up,
and our hope is lost. We are completely
cut off.’
12 Therefore prophesy, and tell them,
‘The Lord Yahweh says: “Behold, I will
open your graves, and cause you to come
up out of your graves, my people; and I
will bring you into the land of Israel.
13 You will know that I am Yahweh,
when I have opened your graves and
caused you to come up out of your graves,
my people.
14 I will put my Spirit in you, and you
will live. Then I will place you in your
own land; and you will know that I,
Yahweh, have spoken it and performed
it,” says Yahweh.’ ”

15 Yahweh’s word came again to me,
saying,
16 “You, son of man, take one stick and
write on it, ‘For Judah, and for the
children of Israel his companions.’ Then
take another stick, and write on it, ‘For
Joseph, the stick of Ephraim, and for all
the house of Israel his companions.’
17 Then join them for yourself to one
another into one stick, that they may
become one in your hand.

18 “When the children of your people
speak to you, saying, ‘Won’t you show us
what you mean by these?’
19 tell them, ‘The Lord Yahweh says:
“Behold, I will take the stick of Joseph,
which is in the hand of Ephraim, and the
tribes of Israel his companions; and I will
put them with it, with the stick of Judah,
and make them one stick, and they will be
one in my hand.
20 The sticks on which you write will be
in your hand before their eyes.” ’
21 Say to them, ‘The Lord Yahweh says:
“Behold, I will take the children of Israel
from among the nations where they have
gone, and will gather them on every side,
and bring them into their own land.
22 I will make them one nation in the
land, on the mountains of Israel. One king
will be king to them all. They will no
longer be two nations. They won’t be
divided into two kingdoms any more at
all.
23 They won’t defile themselves any
more with their idols, nor with their
detestable things, nor with any of their
transgressions; but I will save them out of
all their dwelling places in which they
have sinned, and will cleanse them. So
they will be my people, and I will be their
God.

24 “ ‘ “My servant David will be king
over them. They all will have one
shepherd. They will also walk in my
ordinances and observe my statutes, and
do them.
25 They will dwell in the land that I have
given to Jacob my servant, in which your
fathers lived. They will dwell therein,
they, and their children, and their
children’s children, forever. David my
servant will be their prince forever.
26 Moreover I will make a covenant of
peace with them. It will be an everlasting
covenant with them. I will place them,
multiply them, and will set my sanctuary
among them forever more.

27 My tent also will be with them. I will
be their God, and they will be my people.
28 The nations will know that I am
Yahweh who sanctifies Israel, when my
sanctuary is among them forever
more.” ’ ”

38

1 Yahweh’s word came to me, saying,
2 “Son of man, set your face toward Gog,
of the land of Magog, the prince of Rosh,
Meshech, and Tubal, and prophesy
against him,
3 and say, ‘The Lord Yahweh says:
“Behold, I am against you, Gog, prince of
Rosh, Meshech, and Tubal.
4 I will turn you around, and put hooks
into your jaws, and I will bring you out,
with all your army, horses and horsemen,
all of them clothed in full armor, a great
company with buckler and shield, all of
them handling swords;
5 Persia, Cush, and Put with them, all of
them with shield and helmet;
6 Gomer, and all his hordes; the house of
Togarmah in the uttermost parts of the
north, and all his hordes—even many
peoples with you.
7 “ ‘ “Be prepared, yes, prepare yourself,
you, and all your companies who are
assembled to you, and be a guard to them.
8 After many days you will be visited. In
the latter years you will come into the
land that is brought back from the sword,
that is gathered out of many peoples, on
the mountains of Israel, which have been
a continual waste; but it is brought out of
the peoples and they will dwell securely,
all of them.
9 You will ascend. You will come like a
storm. You will be like a cloud to cover the
land, you and all your hordes, and many
peoples with you.”
10 “ ‘The Lord Yahweh says: “It will
happen in that day that things will come
into your mind, and you will devise an
evil plan.
11 You will say, ‘I will go up to the land of
unwalled villages. I will go to those who
are at rest, who dwell securely, all of them
dwelling without walls, and having
neither bars nor gates,
12 to take the plunder and to take prey;
to turn your hand against the waste places
that are inhabited, and against the people
who are gathered out of the nations, who
have gotten livestock and goods, who
dwell in the middle of the earth.’
13 Sheba, Dedan, and the merchants of
Tarshish, with all its young lions, will ask
you, ‘Have you come to take the plunder?
Have you assembled your company to
take the prey, to carry away silver and
gold, to take away livestock and goods, to
take great plunder?’ ” ’
14 “Therefore, son of man, prophesy,
and tell Gog, ‘The Lord Yahweh says: “In
that day when my people Israel dwells
securely, will you not know it?
15 You will come from your place out of
the uttermost parts of the north, you, and
many peoples with you, all of them riding
on horses, a great company and a mighty
army.
16 You will come up against my people
Israel as a cloud to cover the land. It will
happen in the latter days that I will bring
you against my land, that the nations may
know me when I am sanctified in you,
Gog, before their eyes.”
17 “ ‘The Lord Yahweh says: “Are you he
of whom I spoke in old time by my
servants the prophets of Israel, who
prophesied in those days for years that I
would bring you against them?
18 It will happen in that day, when Gog
comes against the land of Israel,” says the
Lord Yahweh, “that my wrath will come
up into my nostrils.
19 For in my jealousy and in the fire of
my wrath I have spoken. Surely in that
day there will be a great shaking in the
land of Israel,
20 so that the fish of the sea, the birds of
the sky, the animals of the field, all
creeping things who creep on the earth,
and all the men who are on the surface of
the earth will shake at my presence. Then
the mountains will be thrown down, the
steep places will fall, and every wall will
fall to the ground.
21 I will call for a sword against him to
all my mountains,” says the Lord Yahweh.

“Every man’s sword will be against his brother.
22 I will enter into judgment with him
with pestilence and with blood. I will rain
on him, on his hordes, and on the many
peoples who are with him, torrential rains
with great hailstones, fire, and sulfur.
23 I will magnify myself and sanctify
myself, and I will make myself known in
the eyes of many nations. Then they will
know that I am Yahweh.” ’

39

1 “You, son of man, prophesy against
Gog, and say, ‘The Lord Yahweh says:
“Behold, I am against you, Gog, prince of
Rosh, Meshech, and Tubal.
2 I will turn you around, will lead you
on, and will cause you to come up from
the uttermost parts of the north; and I will
bring you onto the mountains of Israel.
3 I will strike your bow out of your left
hand, and will cause your arrows to fall
out of your right hand.
4 You will fall on the mountains of
Israel, you, and all your hordes, and the
peoples who are with you. I will give you
to the ravenous birds of every sort and to
the animals of the field to be devoured.
5 You will fall on the open field, for I
have spoken it,” says the Lord Yahweh.
6 “I will send a fire on Magog and on
those who dwell securely in the islands.
Then they will know that I am Yahweh.
7 “ ‘ “I will make my holy name known
among my people Israel. I won’t allow my
holy name to be profaned any more. Then
the nations will know that I am Yahweh,
the Holy One in Israel.
8 Behold, it comes, and it will be done,”
says the Lord Yahweh. “This is the day
about which I have spoken.
9 “ ‘ “Those who dwell in the cities of
Israel will go out and will make fires of the
weapons and burn them, both the shields
and the bucklers, the bows and the
arrows, and the war clubs and the spears,
and they will make fires with them for
seven years;
10 so that they will take no wood out of
the field, and not cut down any out of the
forests; for they will make fires with the
weapons. They will plunder those who
plundered them, and rob those who
robbed them,” says the Lord Yahweh.
11 “ ‘ “It will happen in that day, that I
will give to Gog a place for burial in Israel,
the valley of those who pass through on
the east of the sea; and it will stop those
who pass through. They will bury Gog and
all his multitude there, and they will call it
‘The valley of Hamon Gog’.
12 “ ‘ “The house of Israel will be burying
them for seven months, that they may
cleanse the land.
13 Yes, all the people of the land will
bury them; and they will become famous
in the day that I will be glorified,” says the
Lord Yahweh.
14 “ ‘ “They will set apart men of
continual employment who will pass
through the land. Those who pass
through will go with those who bury those
who remain on the surface of the land, to
cleanse it. After the end of seven months
they will search.
15 Those who search through the land
will pass through; and when anyone sees
a man’s bone, then he will set up a sign by
it, until the undertakers have buried it in
the valley of Hamon Gog.
16 Hamonah will also be the name of a
city. Thus they will cleanse the land.” ’
17 “You, son of man, the Lord Yahweh
says: ‘Speak to the birds of every sort, and
to every animal of the field, “Assemble
yourselves, and come; gather yourselves
on every side to my sacrifice that I
sacrifice for you, even a great sacrifice on
the mountains of Israel, that you may eat
meat and drink blood.
18 You shall eat the flesh of the mighty,
and drink the blood of the princes of the
earth, of rams, of lambs, and of goats, of
bulls, all of them fatlings of Bashan.
19 You shall eat fat until you are full, and
drink blood until you are drunk, of my
sacrifice which I have sacrificed for you.
20 You shall be filled at my table with
horses and charioteers, with mighty men,
and with all men of war,” says the Lord
Yahweh.’

21 “I will set my glory among the
nations. Then all the nations will see my
judgment that I have executed, and my
hand that I have laid on them.
22 So the house of Israel will know that I
am Yahweh their God, from that day and
forward.
23 The nations will know that the house
of Israel went into captivity for their
iniquity, because they trespassed against
me, and I hid my face from them; so I gave
them into the hand of their adversaries,
and they all fell by the sword.
24 I did to them according to their
uncleanness and according to their
transgressions. I hid my face from them.
25 “Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
‘Now I will reverse the captivity of Jacob
and have mercy on the whole house of
Israel. I will be jealous for my holy name.
26 They will forget their shame and all
their trespasses by which they have
trespassed against me, when they dwell
securely in their land. No one will make
them afraid
27 when I have brought them back from
the peoples, gathered them out of their
enemies’ lands, and am shown holy
among them in the sight of many nations.
28 They will know that I am Yahweh
their God, in that I caused them to go into
captivity among the nations, and have
gathered them to their own land. Then I
will leave none of them captive any more.
29 I won’t hide my face from them any
more, for I have poured out my Spirit on
the house of Israel,’ says the Lord
Yahweh.”

40

1 In the twenty-fifth year of our
captivity, in the beginning of the year, in
the tenth day of the month, in the
fourteenth year after the city was struck,
in the same day, Yahweh’s hand was on
me, and he brought me there.
2 In the visions of God he brought me
into the land of Israel, and set me down on
a very high mountain, on which was
something like the frame of a city to the
south.
3 He brought me there; and, behold,
there was a man whose appearance was
like the appearance of bronze, with a line
of flax in his hand and a measuring reed;
and he stood in the gate.
4 The man said to me, “Son of man, see
with your eyes, and hear with your ears,
and set your heart on all that I will show
you; for you have been brought here so
that I may show them to you. Declare all
that you see to the house of Israel.”
5 Behold, there was a wall on the outside
of the house all around, and in the man’s
hand a measuring reed six cubits† long, of
a cubit and a hand width each. So he
measured the thickness of the building,
one reed; and the height, one reed.
6 Then he came to the gate which looks
toward the east, and went up its steps. He
measured the threshold of the gate, one
reed wide; and the other threshold, one
reed wide.
7 Every lodge was one reed long and one
reed wide. Between the lodges was five
cubits. The threshold of the gate by the
porch of the gate toward the house was
one reed.
8 He measured also the porch of the gate
toward the house, one reed.
9 Then he measured the porch of the
gate, eight cubits; and its posts, two cubits;
and the porch of the gate was toward the
house.
10 The side rooms of the gate eastward
were three on this side, and three on that
side. The three of them were of one
measure. The posts had one measure on
this side and on that side.
11 He measured the width of the
opening of the gate, ten cubits; and the
length of the gate, thirteen cubits;
12 and a border before the lodges, one
cubit on this side, and a border, one cubit
on that side; and the side rooms, six cubits
on this side, and six cubits on that side.

† **40:5** A normal cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. A handbreadth is about 4.3 inches or 11 centimeters, so the long cubit described here would be about 22.3 inches or 57 centimeters long. Thus, a 6 long cubit measuring reed would have been about 3 yards 26.6 inches or about 3.42 meters long.

13 He measured the gate from the roof of
the one side room to the roof of the other,
a width of twenty-five cubits, door against
door.
14 He also made posts, sixty cubits; and
the court reached to the posts, around the
gate.
15 From the forefront of the gate at the
entrance to the forefront of the inner
porch of the gate were fifty cubits.
16 There were closed windows to the
side rooms, and to their posts within the
gate all around, and likewise to the
arches. Windows were around inward.
Palm trees were on each post.
17 Then he brought me into the outer
court. Behold, there were rooms and a
pavement made for the court all around.
Thirty rooms were on the pavement.
18 The pavement was by the side of the
gates, corresponding to the length of the
gates, even the lower pavement.
19 Then he measured the width from the
forefront of the lower gate to the forefront
of the inner court outside, one hundred
cubits, both on the east and on the north.
20 He measured the length and width of
the gate of the outer court which faces
toward the north.
21 The lodges of it were three on this
side and three on that side. Its posts and
its arches were the same as the measure
of the first gate: its length was fifty cubits,
and the width twenty-five cubits.
22 Its windows, its arches, and its palm
trees were the same as the measure of the
gate which faces toward the east. They
went up to it by seven steps. Its arches
were before them.
23 There was a gate to the inner court
facing the other gate, on the north and on
the east. He measured one hundred cubits
from gate to gate.
24 He led me toward the south; and
behold, there was a gate toward the south.
He measured its posts and its arches
according to these measurements.
25 There were windows in it and in its
arches all around, like the other windows:
the length was fifty cubits, and the width
twenty-five cubits.
26 There were seven steps to go up to it,
and its arches were before them. It had
palm trees, one on this side, and another
on that side, on its posts.
27 There was a gate to the inner court
toward the south. He measured one
hundred cubits from gate to gate toward
the south.
28 Then he brought me to the inner court
by the south gate. He measured the south
gate according to these measurements;
29 with its lodges, its posts, and its
arches, according to these measurements.
There were windows in it and in its
arches all around. It was fifty cubits long,
and twenty-five cubits wide.
30 There were arches all around,
twenty-five cubits long and five cubits
wide.
31 Its arches were toward the outer
court. Palm trees were on its posts. The
ascent to it had eight steps.
32 He brought me into the inner court
toward the east. He measured the gate
according to these measurements;
33 with its lodges, its posts, and its
arches, according to these measurements.
There were windows in it and in its
arches all around. It was fifty cubits long,
and twenty-five cubits wide.
34 Its arches were toward the outer
court. Palm trees were on its posts on this
side and on that side. The ascent to it had
eight steps.
35 He brought me to the north gate, and
he measured it according to these
measurements—
36 its lodges, its posts, and its arches.
There were windows in it all around. The
length was fifty cubits and the width
twenty-five cubits.
37 Its posts were toward the outer court.
Palm trees were on its posts on this side
and on that side. The ascent to it had eight
steps.
38 A room with its door was by the posts
at the gates. They washed the burnt
offering there.
39 In the porch of the gate were two
tables on this side and two tables on that
side, on which to kill the burnt offering,
the sin offering, and the trespass offering.
40 On the one side outside, as one goes
up to the entry of the gate toward the

north, were two tables; and on the other side, which belonged to the porch of the gate, were two tables.
41 Four tables were on this side, and four tables on that side, by the side of the gate: eight tables, on which they killed the sacrifices.
42 There were four cut stone tables for the burnt offering, a cubit and a half long, a cubit and a half wide, and one cubit high. They laid the instruments with which they killed the burnt offering and the sacrifice on them.
43 The hooks, a hand width long, were fastened within all around. The meat of the offering was on the tables.
44 Outside of the inner gate were rooms for the singers in the inner court, which was at the side of the north gate. They faced toward the south. One at the side of the east gate faced toward the north.
45 He said to me, "This room, which faces toward the south, is for the priests who perform the duty of the house.
46 The room which faces toward the north is for the priests who perform the duty of the altar. These are the sons of Zadok, who from among the sons of Levi come near to Yahweh to minister to him."
47 He measured the court, one hundred cubits long and one hundred cubits wide, square. The altar was before the house.
48 Then he brought me to the porch of the house, and measured each post of the porch, five cubits on this side, and five cubits on that side. The width of the gate was three cubits on this side and three cubits on that side.
49 The length of the porch was twenty cubits and the width eleven cubits, even by the steps by which they went up to it. There were pillars by the posts, one on this side, and another on that side.

41

1 He brought me to the nave and measured the posts, six cubits wide on the one side and six cubits wide on the other side, which was the width of the tent.
2 The width of the entrance was ten cubits,† and the sides of the entrance were five cubits on the one side, and five cubits on the other side. He measured its length, forty cubits, and the width, twenty cubits.
3 Then he went inward and measured each post of the entrance, two cubits; and the entrance, six cubits; and the width of the entrance, seven cubits.
4 He measured its length, twenty cubits, and the width, twenty cubits, before the nave. He said to me, "This is the most holy place."
5 Then he measured the wall of the house, six cubits; and the width of every side room, four cubits, all around the house on every side.
6 The side rooms were in three stories, one over another, and thirty in each story. They entered into the wall which belonged to the house for the side rooms all around, that they might be supported and not penetrate the wall of the house.
7 The side rooms were wider on the higher levels, because the walls were narrower at the higher levels. Therefore the width of the house increased upward; and so one went up from the lowest level to the highest through the middle level.
8 I saw also that the house had a raised base all around. The foundations of the side rooms were a full reed of six great cubits.
9 The thickness of the outer wall of the side rooms was five cubits. That which was left was the place of the side rooms that belonged to the house.
10 Between the rooms was a width of twenty cubits around the house on every side.
11 The doors of the side rooms were toward an open area that was left, one door toward the north, and another door toward the south. The width of the open area was five cubits all around.
12 The building that was before the separate place at the side toward the west was seventy cubits wide; and the wall of the building was five cubits thick all around, and its length ninety cubits.
13 So he measured the temple, one hundred cubits long; and the separate

† **41:2** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

place, and the building, with its walls, one hundred cubits long;
14 also the width of the face of the temple, and of the separate place toward the east, one hundred cubits.
15 He measured the length of the building before the separate place which was at its back, and its galleries on the one side and on the other side, one hundred cubits from the inner temple, and the porches of the court,
16 the thresholds, and the closed windows, and the galleries around on their three stories, opposite the threshold, with wood ceilings all around, and from the ground up to the windows, (now the windows were covered),
17 to the space above the door, even to the inner house, and outside, and by all the wall all around inside and outside, by measure.
18 It was made with cherubim and palm trees. A palm tree was between cherub and cherub, and every cherub had two faces,
19 so that there was the face of a man toward the palm tree on the one side, and the face of a young lion toward the palm tree on the other side. It was made like this through all the house all around.
20 Cherubim and palm trees were made from the ground to above the door. The wall of the temple was like this.
21 The door posts of the nave were squared. As for the face of the nave, its appearance was as the appearance of the temple.
22 The altar was of wood, three cubits high, and its length two cubits. Its corners, its base, and its walls were of wood. He said to me, “This is the table that is before Yahweh.”
23 The temple and the sanctuary had two doors.
24 The doors had two leaves each, two turning leaves: two for the one door, and two leaves for the other.
25 There were made on them, on the doors of the nave, cherubim and palm trees, like those made on the walls. There was a threshold of wood on the face of the porch outside.
26 There were closed windows and palm trees on the one side and on the other side, on the sides of the porch. This is how the side rooms of the temple and the thresholds were arranged.

42

1 Then he brought me out into the outer court, the way toward the north. Then he brought me into the room that was opposite the separate place, and which was opposite the building toward the north.
2 Facing the length of one hundred cubits† was the north door, and the width was fifty cubits.
3 Opposite the twenty cubits which belonged to the inner court, and opposite the pavement which belonged to the outer court, was gallery against gallery in the three stories.
4 Before the rooms was a walk of ten cubits’ width inward, a way of one cubit; and their doors were toward the north.
5 Now the upper rooms were shorter; for the galleries took away from these more than from the lower and the middle in the building.
6 For they were in three stories, and they didn’t have pillars as the pillars of the courts. Therefore the uppermost was set back more than the lowest and the middle from the ground.
7 The wall that was outside by the side of the rooms, toward the outer court before the rooms, was fifty cubits long.
8 For the length of the rooms that were in the outer court was fifty cubits. Behold, those facing the temple were one hundred cubits.
9 From under these rooms was the entry on the east side, as one goes into them from the outer court.
10 In the thickness of the wall of the court toward the east, before the separate place, and before the building, there were rooms.
11 The way before them was like the appearance of the rooms which were

† **42:2** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

toward the north. Their length and width were the same. All their exits had the same arrangement and doors.
12 Like the doors of the rooms that were toward the south was a door at the head of the way, even the way directly before the wall toward the east, as one enters into them.
13 Then he said to me, “The north rooms and the south rooms, which are opposite the separate place, are the holy rooms, where the priests who are near to Yahweh shall eat the most holy things. There they shall lay the most holy things, with the meal offering, the sin offering, and the trespass offering; for the place is holy.
14 When the priests enter in, then they shall not go out of the holy place into the outer court until they lay their garments in which they minister there; for they are holy. Then they shall put on other garments, and shall approach that which is for the people.”
15 Now when he had finished measuring the inner house, he brought me out by the way of the gate which faces toward the east, and measured it all around.
16 He measured on the east side with the measuring reed five hundred reeds, with the measuring reed all around.
17 He measured on the north side five hundred reeds with the measuring reed all around.
18 He measured on the south side five hundred reeds with the measuring reed.
19 He turned about to the west side, and measured five hundred reeds with the measuring reed.
20 He measured it on the four sides. It had a wall around it, the length five hundred cubits, and the width five hundred cubits, to make a separation between that which was holy and that which was common.

43

1 Afterward he brought me to the gate, even the gate that looks toward the east.
2 Behold, the glory of the God of Israel came from the way of the east. His voice was like the sound of many waters; and the earth was illuminated with his glory.
3 It was like the appearance of the vision which I saw, even according to the vision that I saw when I came to destroy the city; and the visions were like the vision that I saw by the river Chebar; and I fell on my face.
4 Yahweh’s glory came into the house by the way of the gate which faces toward the east.
5 The Spirit took me up and brought me into the inner court; and behold, Yahweh’s glory filled the house.
6 I heard one speaking to me out of the house, and a man stood by me.
7 He said to me, “Son of man, this is the place of my throne and the place of the soles of my feet, where I will dwell among the children of Israel forever. The house of Israel will no more defile my holy name, neither they nor their kings, by their prostitution and by the dead bodies of their kings in their high places;
8 in their setting of their threshold by my threshold and their door post beside my door post. There was a wall between me and them; and they have defiled my holy name by their abominations which they have committed. Therefore I have consumed them in my anger.
9 Now let them put away their prostitution, and the dead bodies of their kings far from me. Then I will dwell among them forever.
10 “You, son of man, show the house to the house of Israel, that they may be ashamed of their iniquities; and let them measure the pattern.
11 If they are ashamed of all that they have done, make known to them the form of the house, its fashion, its exits, its entrances, its structure, all its ordinances, all its forms, and all its laws; and write it in their sight, that they may keep the whole form of it, and all its ordinances, and do them.
12 “This is the law of the house. On the top of the mountain the whole limit

† **43:13** A normal cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. A hand width is about 4.3 inches or 11 cm.

around it shall be most holy. Behold, this is the law of the house.
13 "These are the measurements of the altar by cubits (the cubit† is a cubit and a hand width): the bottom shall be a cubit, and the width a cubit, and its border around its edge a span;‡ and this shall be the base of the altar.
14 From the bottom on the ground to the lower ledge shall be two cubits, and the width one cubit; and from the lesser ledge to the greater ledge shall be four cubits, and the width a cubit.
15 The upper altar shall be four cubits; and from the altar hearth and upward there shall be four horns.
16 The altar hearth shall be twelve cubits long by twelve wide, square in its four sides.
17 The ledge shall be fourteen cubits long by fourteen wide in its four sides; and the border about it shall be half a cubit; and its bottom shall be a cubit around; and its steps shall look toward the east."
18 He said to me, "Son of man, the Lord Yahweh says: 'These are the ordinances of the altar in the day when they make it, to offer burnt offerings on it, and to sprinkle blood on it.
19 You shall give to the Levitical priests who are of the offspring of Zadok, who are near to me, to minister to me,' says the Lord Yahweh, 'a young bull for a sin offering.
20 You shall take of its blood and put it on its four horns, and on the four corners of the ledge, and on the border all around. You shall cleanse it and make atonement for it that way.
21 You shall also take the bull of the sin offering, and it shall be burned in the appointed place of the house, outside of the sanctuary.
22 "On the second day you shall offer a male goat without defect for a sin offering; and they shall cleanse the altar, as they cleansed it with the bull.
23 When you have finished cleansing it, you shall offer a young bull without defect and a ram out of the flock without defect.
24 You shall bring them near to Yahweh, and the priests shall cast salt on them, and they shall offer them up for a burnt offering to Yahweh.
25 "Seven days you shall prepare every day a goat for a sin offering. They shall also prepare a young bull and a ram out of the flock, without defect.
26 Seven days shall they make atonement for the altar and purify it. So shall they consecrate it.
27 When they have accomplished the days, it shall be that on the eighth day and onward, the priests shall make your burnt offerings on the altar and your peace offerings. Then I will accept you,' says the Lord Yahweh."

44

1 Then he brought me back by the way of the outer gate of the sanctuary, which looks toward the east; and it was shut.
2 Yahweh said to me, "This gate shall be shut. It shall not be opened, no man shall enter in by it; for Yahweh, the God of Israel, has entered in by it. Therefore it shall be shut.
3 As for the prince, he shall sit in it as prince to eat bread before Yahweh. He shall enter by the way of the porch of the gate, and shall go out the same way."
4 Then he brought me by the way of the north gate before the house; and I looked, and behold, Yahweh's glory filled Yahweh's house; so I fell on my face.
5 Yahweh said to me, "Son of man, mark well, and see with your eyes, and hear with your ears all that I tell you concerning all the ordinances of Yahweh's house and all its laws; and mark well the entrance of the house, with every exit of the sanctuary.
6 You shall tell the rebellious, even the house of Israel, 'The Lord Yahweh says: "You house of Israel, let that be enough of all your abominations,
7 in that you have brought in foreigners, uncircumcised in heart and uncircumcised in flesh, to be in my

‡ **43:13** A span is the length from the tip of a man's thumb to the tip of his little finger when his hand is stretched out (about half a cubit, or 9 inches, or 22.8 cm.)

sanctuary, to profane it, even my house,
when you offer my bread, the fat and the
blood; and they have broken my
covenant, to add to all your abominations.
8 You have not performed the duty of
my holy things; but you have set
performers of my duty in my sanctuary
for yourselves."
9 The Lord Yahweh says, "No foreigner,
uncircumcised in heart and
uncircumcised in flesh, shall enter into
my sanctuary, of any foreigners who are
among the children of Israel.
10 " ' "But the Levites who went far from
me when Israel went astray, who went
astray from me after their idols, they will
bear their iniquity.
11 Yet they shall be ministers in my
sanctuary, having oversight at the gates of
the house, and ministering in the house.
They shall kill the burnt offering and the
sacrifice for the people, and they shall
stand before them to minister to them.
12 Because they ministered to them
before their idols, and became a
stumbling block of iniquity to the house of
Israel, therefore I have lifted up my hand
against them," says the Lord Yahweh,
"and they will bear their iniquity.
13 They shall not come near to me, to
execute the office of priest to me, nor to
come near to any of my holy things, to the
things that are most holy; but they will
bear their shame and their abominations
which they have committed.
14 Yet I will make them performers of
the duty of the house, for all its service
and for all that will be done therein.
15 " ' "But the Levitical priests, the sons
of Zadok, who performed the duty of my
sanctuary when the children of Israel
went astray from me, shall come near to
me to minister to me. They shall stand
before me to offer to me the fat and the
blood," says the Lord Yahweh.
16 "They shall enter into my sanctuary,
and they shall come near to my table, to
minister to me, and they shall keep my
instruction.
17 " ' "It will be that when they enter in
at the gates of the inner court, they shall
be clothed with linen garments. No wool
shall come on them while they minister in
the gates of the inner court, and within.
18 They shall have linen turbans on
their heads, and shall have linen trousers
on their waists. They shall not clothe
themselves with anything that makes
them sweat.
19 When they go out into the outer court,
even into the outer court to the people,
they shall put off their garments in which
they minister and lay them in the holy
rooms. They shall put on other garments,
that they not sanctify the people with
their garments.
20 " ' "They shall not shave their heads,
or allow their locks to grow long. They
shall only cut off the hair of their heads.
21 None of the priests shall drink wine
when they enter into the inner court.
22 They shall not take for their wives a
widow, or her who is put away; but they
shall take virgins of the offspring of the
house of Israel, or a widow who is the
widow of a priest.
23 They shall teach my people the
difference between the holy and the
common, and cause them to discern
between the unclean and the clean.
24 " ' "In a controversy they shall stand
to judge. They shall judge it according to
my ordinances. They shall keep my laws
and my statutes in all my appointed
feasts. They shall make my Sabbaths holy.
25 " ' "They shall go in to no dead person
to defile themselves; but for father, or for
mother, or for son, or for daughter, for
brother, or for sister who has had no
husband, they may defile themselves.
26 After he is cleansed, they shall reckon
to him seven days.
27 In the day that he goes into the
sanctuary, into the inner court, to
minister in the sanctuary, he shall offer
his sin offering," says the Lord Yahweh.
28 " 'They shall have an inheritance: I
am their inheritance; and you shall give
them no possession in Israel. I am their
possession.
29 They shall eat the meal offering, and
the sin offering, and the trespass offering;

and every devoted thing in Israel shall be theirs.
30 The first of all the first fruits of every thing, and every offering of everything, of all your offerings, shall be for the priest. You shall also give to the priests the first of your dough, to cause a blessing to rest on your house.
31 The priests shall not eat of anything that dies of itself or is torn, whether it is bird or animal.

45

1 " ' "Moreover, when you divide by lot the land for inheritance, you shall offer an offering to Yahweh, a holy portion of the land. The length shall be the length of twenty-five thousand reeds, and the width shall be ten thousand. It shall be holy in all its border all around.
2 Of this there shall be a five hundred by five hundred square for the holy place, and fifty cubits† for its pasture lands all around.
3 Of this measure you shall measure a length of twenty-five thousand, and a width of ten thousand. In it shall be the sanctuary, which is most holy.
4 It is a holy portion of the land; it shall be for the priests, the ministers of the sanctuary, who come near to minister to Yahweh. It shall be a place for their houses and a holy place for the sanctuary.
5 Twenty-five thousand cubits in length and ten thousand in width shall be for the Levites, the ministers of the house, as a possession for themselves, for twenty rooms.
6 " ' "You shall appoint the possession of the city five thousand cubits wide and twenty-five thousand long, side by side with the offering of the holy portion. It shall be for the whole house of Israel.
7 " ' "What is for the prince shall be on the one side and on the other side of the holy allotment and of the possession of the city, in front of the holy allotment and in front of the possession of the city, on the west side westward, and on the east side eastward, and in length corresponding to one of the portions, from the west border to the east border.
8 In the land it shall be to him for a possession in Israel. My princes shall no more oppress my people, but they shall give the land to the house of Israel according to their tribes."
9 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "Enough, you princes of Israel! Remove violence and plunder, and execute justice and righteousness! Stop dispossessing my people!" says the Lord Yahweh.
10 "You shall have just balances, a just ephah,‡ and a just bath.
11 The ephah and the bath shall be of one measure, that the bath may contain one tenth of a homer,§ and the ephah one tenth of a homer. Its measure shall be the same as the homer.
12 The shekel† shall be twenty gerahs.‡ Twenty shekels plus twenty-five shekels plus fifteen shekels shall be your mina.§
13 " ' "This is the offering that you shall offer: the sixth part of an ephah from a homer of wheat, and you shall give the sixth part of an ephah from a homer of barley,
14 and the set portion of oil, of the bath of oil, one tenth of a bath out of the cor, which is ten baths, even a homer (for ten baths are a homer),†
15 and one lamb of the flock out of two hundred, from the well-watered pastures of Israel—for a meal offering, for a burnt offering, and for peace offerings, to make atonement for them," says the Lord Yahweh.
16 "All the people of the land shall give to this offering for the prince in Israel.
17 It shall be the prince's part to give the burnt offerings, the meal offerings, and the drink offerings, in the feasts, and on the new moons, and on the Sabbaths, in

† **45:2** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. ‡ **45:10** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel § **45:11** 1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels † **45:12** A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. ‡ **45:12** a gerah is about 0.5 grams or about 7.7 grains § **45:12** A mina is about 600 grams or 1.3 U. S. pounds. † **45:14** 1 cor is the same as 1 homer in volume, and is about 211 liters, 55.9 gallons, or 6 bushels. 1 bath is about 21.1 liters, 5.59 gallons, or 2.4 pecks.

all the appointed feasts of the house of
Israel. He shall prepare the sin offering,
the meal offering, the burnt offering, and
the peace offerings, to make atonement
for the house of Israel."
18 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "In the first
month, on the first day of the month, you
shall take a young bull without defect, and
you shall cleanse the sanctuary.
19 The priest shall take of the blood of
the sin offering and put it on the door
posts of the house, and on the four
corners of the ledge of the altar, and on
the posts of the gate of the inner court.
20 So you shall do on the seventh day of
the month for everyone who errs, and for
him who is simple. So you shall make
atonement for the house.
21 " ' "In the first month, on the
fourteenth day of the month, you shall
have the Passover, a feast of seven days;
unleavened bread shall be eaten.
22 On that day the prince shall prepare
for himself and for all the people of the
land a bull for a sin offering.
23 The seven days of the feast he shall
prepare a burnt offering to Yahweh,
seven bulls and seven rams without
defect daily the seven days; and a male
goat daily for a sin offering.
24 He shall prepare a meal offering, an
ephah‡ for a bull, an ephah for a ram, and
a hin§ of oil to an ephah.
25 " ' "In the seventh month, on the
fifteenth day of the month, during the
feast, he shall do like that for seven days.
He shall make the same provision for sin
offering, the burnt offering, the meal
offering, and the oil."

46

1 " 'The Lord Yahweh says: "The gate of
the inner court that looks toward the east
shall be shut the six working days; but on
the Sabbath day it shall be opened, and on
the day of the new moon it shall be
opened.
2 The prince shall enter by the way of
the porch of the gate outside, and shall
stand by the post of the gate; and the
priests shall prepare his burnt offering
and his peace offerings, and he shall
worship at the threshold of the gate. Then
he shall go out, but the gate shall not be
shut until the evening.
3 The people of the land shall worship at
the door of that gate before Yahweh on
the Sabbaths and on the new moons.
4 The burnt offering that the prince
shall offer to Yahweh shall be on the
Sabbath day, six lambs without defect and
a ram without defect;
5 and the meal offering shall be an
ephah for the ram, and the meal offering
for the lambs as he is able to give, and a
hin† of oil to an ephah.‡
6 On the day of the new moon it shall be
a young bull without defect, six lambs,
and a ram. They shall be without defect.
7 He shall prepare a meal offering: an
ephah for the bull, and an ephah for the
ram, and for the lambs according as he is
able, and a hin of oil to an ephah.
8 When the prince enters, he shall go in
by the way of the porch of the gate, and he
shall go out by its way.
9 " ' "But when the people of the land
come before Yahweh in the appointed
feasts, he who enters by the way of the
north gate to worship shall go out by the
way of the south gate; and he who enters
by the way of the south gate shall go out
by the way of the north gate. He shall not
return by the way of the gate by which he
came in, but shall go out straight before
him.
10 The prince shall go in with them
when they go in. When they go out, he
shall go out.
11 " ' "In the feasts and in the appointed
holidays, the meal offering shall be an
ephah§ for a bull, and an ephah for a ram,
and for the lambs as he is able to give, and
a hin of oil to an ephah.

‡ **45:24** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel § **45:24** A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons. † **46:5** A hin is about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons. ‡ **46:5** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel § **46:11** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

12 When the prince prepares a free will
offering, a burnt offering or peace
offerings as a free will offering to Yahweh,
one shall open for him the gate that looks
toward the east; and he shall prepare his
burnt offering and his peace offerings, as
he does on the Sabbath day. Then he shall
go out; and after his going out one shall
shut the gate.

13 “ ‘ “You shall prepare a lamb a year
old without defect for a burnt offering to
Yahweh daily. Morning by morning you
shall prepare it.
14 You shall prepare a meal offering
with it morning by morning, the sixth part
of an ephah,† and the third part of a hin of
oil to moisten the fine flour; a meal
offering to Yahweh continually by a
perpetual ordinance.
15 Thus they shall prepare the lamb, the
meal offering, and the oil, morning by
morning, for a continual burnt offering.”

16 “ ‘The Lord Yahweh says: “If the
prince gives a gift to any of his sons, it is
his inheritance. It shall belong to his sons.
It is their possession by inheritance.
17 But if he gives of his inheritance a gift
to one of his servants, it shall be his to the
year of liberty; then it shall return to the
prince; but as for his inheritance, it shall
be for his sons.
18 Moreover the prince shall not take of
the people’s inheritance, to thrust them
out of their possession. He shall give
inheritance to his sons out of his own
possession, that my people not each be
scattered from his possession.” ’ ”

19 Then he brought me through the
entry, which was at the side of the gate,
into the holy rooms for the priests, which
looked toward the north. Behold, there
was a place on the back part westward.
20 He said to me, “This is the place
where the priests shall boil the trespass
offering and the sin offering, and where
they shall bake the meal offering, that
they not bring them out into the outer
court, to sanctify the people.”
21 Then he brought me out into the outer
court and caused me to pass by the four
corners of the court; and behold, in every
corner of the court there was a court.
22 In the four corners of the court there
were courts enclosed, forty cubits‡ long
and thirty wide. These four in the corners
were the same size.
23 There was a wall around in them,
around the four, and boiling places were
made under the walls all around.
24 Then he said to me, “These are the
boiling houses, where the ministers of the
house shall boil the sacrifice of the
people.”

47

1 He brought me back to the door of the
temple; and behold, waters flowed out
from under the threshold of the temple
eastward, for the front of the temple faced
toward the east. The waters came down
from underneath, from the right side of
the temple, on the south of the altar.
2 Then he brought me out by the way of
the gate northward, and led me around by
the way outside to the outer gate, by the
way of the gate that looks toward the east.
Behold, waters ran out on the right side.
3 When the man went out eastward
with the line in his hand, he measured
one thousand cubits,† and he caused me to
pass through the waters, waters that were
to the ankles.
4 Again he measured one thousand, and
caused me to pass through the waters,
waters that were to the knees. Again he
measured one thousand, and caused me
to pass through waters that were to the
waist.
5 Afterward he measured one thousand;
and it was a river that I could not pass
through, for the waters had risen, waters
to swim in, a river that could not be
walked through.
6 He said to me, “Son of man, have you
seen this?”

† **46:14** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel ‡ **46:22** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. † **47:3** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

Then he brought me and caused me to return to the bank of the river.
7 Now when I had returned, behold, on the bank of the river were very many trees on the one side and on the other.
8 Then he said to me, “These waters flow out toward the eastern region and will go down into the Arabah. Then they will go toward the sea and flow into the sea which will be made to flow out; and the waters will be healed.
9 It will happen that every living creature which swarms, in every place where the rivers come, will live. Then there will be a very great multitude of fish; for these waters have come there, and the waters of the sea will be healed, and everything will live wherever the river comes.
10 It will happen that fishermen will stand by it. From En Gedi even to En Eglaim will be a place for the spreading of nets. Their fish will be after their kinds, as the fish of the great sea, exceedingly many.
11 But its swamps and marshes will not be healed. They will be given up to salt.
12 By the river banks, on both sides, will grow every tree for food, whose leaf won’t wither, neither will its fruit fail. It will produce new fruit every month, because its waters issue out of the sanctuary. Its fruit will be for food, and its leaf for healing.”
13 The Lord Yahweh says: “This shall be the border by which you shall divide the land for inheritance according to the twelve tribes of Israel. Joseph shall have two portions.
14 You shall inherit it, one as well as another; for I swore to give it to your fathers. This land will fall to you for inheritance.
15 “This shall be the border of the land:
“On the north side, from the great sea, by the way of Hethlon, to the entrance of Zedad;
16 Hamath, Berothah, Sibraim (which is between the border of Damascus and the border of Hamath), to Hazer Hatticon, which is by the border of Hauran.
17 The border from the sea shall be Hazar Enon at the border of Damascus; and on the north northward is the border of Hamath. This is the north side.
18 “The east side, between Hauran, Damascus, Gilead, and the land of Israel, shall be the Jordan; from the north border to the east sea you shall measure. This is the east side.
19 “The south side southward shall be from Tamar as far as the waters of Meriboth Kadesh, to the brook, to the great sea. This is the south side southward.
20 “The west side shall be the great sea, from the south border as far as opposite the entrance of Hamath. This is the west side.
21 “So you shall divide this land to yourselves according to the tribes of Israel.
22 You shall divide it by lot for an inheritance to you and to the aliens who live among you, who will father children among you. Then they shall be to you as the native-born among the children of Israel. They shall have inheritance with you among the tribes of Israel.
23 In whatever tribe the stranger lives, there you shall give him his inheritance,” says the Lord Yahweh.

48

1 “Now these are the names of the tribes: From the north end, beside the way of Hethlon to the entrance of Hamath, Hazar Enan at the border of Damascus, northward beside Hamath (and they shall have their sides east and west), Dan, one portion.
2 “By the border of Dan, from the east side to the west side, Asher, one portion.
3 “By the border of Asher, from the east side even to the west side, Naphtali, one portion.
4 “By the border of Naphtali, from the east side to the west side, Manasseh, one portion.
5 “By the border of Manasseh, from the east side to the west side, Ephraim, one portion.
6 “By the border of Ephraim, from the east side even to the west side, Reuben, one portion.

7 “By the border of Reuben, from the
east side to the west side, Judah, one
portion.
8 “By the border of Judah, from the east
side to the west side, shall be the offering
which you shall offer, twenty-five
thousand reeds in width, and in length as
one of the portions, from the east side to
the west side; and the sanctuary shall be
in the middle of it.
9 “The offering that you shall offer to
Yahweh shall be twenty-five thousand
reeds in length, and ten thousand in
width.
10 For these, even for the priests, shall
be the holy offering: toward the north
twenty-five thousand in length, and
toward the west ten thousand in width,
and toward the east ten thousand in
width, and toward the south twenty-five
thousand in length; and the sanctuary of
Yahweh shall be in the middle of it.
11 It shall be for the priests who are
sanctified of the sons of Zadok, who have
kept my instruction, who didn’t go astray
when the children of Israel went astray,
as the Levites went astray.
12 It shall be to them an offering from
the offering of the land, a most holy thing,
by the border of the Levites.
13 “Alongside the border of the priests,
the Levites shall have twenty-five
thousand cubits in length and ten
thousand in width. All the length shall be
twenty-five thousand, and the width ten
thousand.
14 They shall sell none of it, nor
exchange it, nor shall the first fruits of the
land be alienated, for it is holy to Yahweh.
15 “The five thousand cubits that are left
in the width, in front of the twenty-five
thousand, shall be for common use, for
the city, for dwelling and for pasture
lands; and the city shall be in the middle
of it.
16 These shall be its measurements: the
north side four thousand and five
hundred, and the south side four
thousand and five hundred, and on the
east side four thousand and five hundred,
and the west side four thousand and five
hundred.
17 The city shall have pasture lands:
toward the north two hundred fifty, and
toward the south two hundred fifty, and
toward the east two hundred fifty, and
toward the west two hundred fifty.
18 The remainder of the length,
alongside the holy offering, shall be ten
thousand eastward and ten thousand
westward; and it shall be alongside the
holy offering. Its increase shall be for food
to those who labor in the city.
19 Those who labor in the city, out of all
the tribes of Israel, shall cultivate it.
20 All the offering shall be a square of
twenty-five thousand by twenty-five
thousand. You shall offer it as a holy
offering, with the possession of the city.
21 “The remainder shall be for the
prince, on the one side and on the other of
the holy offering and of the possession of
the city; in front of the twenty-five
thousand of the offering toward the east
border, and westward in front of the
twenty-five thousand toward the west
border, alongside the portions, it shall be
for the prince. The holy offering and the
sanctuary of the house shall be in the
middle of it.
22 Moreover, from the possession of the
Levites, and from the possession of the
city, being in the middle of that which is
the prince’s, between the border of Judah
and the border of Benjamin, shall be for
the prince.
23 “As for the rest of the tribes: from the
east side to the west side, Benjamin, one
portion.
24 “By the border of Benjamin, from the
east side to the west side, Simeon, one
portion.
25 “By the border of Simeon, from the
east side to the west side, Issachar, one
portion.
26 “By the border of Issachar, from the
east side to the west side, Zebulun, one
portion.
27 “By the border of Zebulun, from the
east side to the west side, Gad, one
portion.
28 “By the border of Gad, at the south
side southward, the border shall be even

from Tamar to the waters of Meribath
Kadesh, to the brook, to the great sea.
29 “This is the land which you shall
divide by lot to the tribes of Israel for
inheritance, and these are their several
portions, says the Lord Yahweh.
30 “These are the exits of the city: On the
north side four thousand five hundred
reeds by measure;
31 and the gates of the city shall be
named after the tribes of Israel, three
gates northward: the gate of Reuben, one;
the gate of Judah, one; the gate of Levi,
one.
32 “At the east side four thousand five
hundred reeds, and three gates: even the
gate of Joseph, one; the gate of Benjamin,
one; the gate of Dan, one.
33 “At the south side four thousand five
hundred reeds by measure, and three
gates: the gate of Simeon, one; the gate of
Issachar, one; the gate of Zebulun, one.
34 “At the west side four thousand five
hundred reeds, with their three gates: the
gate of Gad, one; the gate of Asher, one;
the gate of Naphtali, one.
35 “It shall be eighteen thousand reeds
in circumference; and the name of the city
from that day shall be, ‘Yahweh is there.’

The Book of Daniel

1 In the third year of the reign of
Jehoiakim king of Judah, Nebuchadnezzar
king of Babylon came to Jerusalem and
besieged it.
2 The Lord† gave Jehoiakim king of
Judah into his hand, with some of the
vessels of the house of God;‡ and he
carried them into the land of Shinar to the
house of his god. He brought the vessels
into the treasure house of his god.
3 The king spoke to Ashpenaz, the
master of his eunuchs, that he should
bring in some of the children of Israel,
even of the royal offspring§ and of the
nobles:
4 youths in whom was no defect, but
well-favored, skillful in all wisdom,
endowed with knowledge, understanding
science, and who had the ability to stand
in the king's palace; and that he should
teach them the learning and the language
of the Chaldeans.
5 The king appointed for them a daily
portion of the king's delicacies and of the
wine which he drank, and that they
should be nourished three years, that at
its end they should stand before the king.
6 Now among these of the children of
Judah were Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael,
and Azariah.
7 The prince of the eunuchs gave names
to them: to Daniel he gave the name
Belteshazzar; to Hananiah, Shadrach; to
Mishael, Meshach; and to Azariah,
Abednego.
8 But Daniel purposed in his heart that
he would not defile himself with the
king's delicacies, nor with the wine which
he drank. Therefore he requested of the
prince of the eunuchs that he might not
defile himself.
9 Now God made Daniel find kindness
and compassion in the sight of the prince
of the eunuchs.
10 The prince of the eunuchs said to
Daniel, "I fear my lord the king, who has
appointed your food and your drink. For
why should he see your faces worse
looking than the youths who are of your
own age? Then you would endanger my
head with the king."
11 Then Daniel said to the steward
whom the prince of the eunuchs had
appointed over Daniel, Hananiah,
Mishael, and Azariah:
12 "Test your servants, I beg you, ten
days; and let them give us vegetables to
eat and water to drink.
13 Then let our faces be examined
before you, and the face of the youths who
eat of the king's delicacies; and as you see,
deal with your servants."
14 So he listened to them in this matter,
and tested them for ten days.
15 At the end of ten days, their faces
appeared fairer and they were fatter in
flesh than all the youths who ate of the
king's delicacies.
16 So the steward took away their
delicacies and the wine that they were
given to drink, and gave them vegetables.
17 Now as for these four youths, God
gave them knowledge and skill in all
learning and wisdom; and Daniel had
understanding in all visions and dreams.
18 At the end of the days which the king
had appointed for bringing them in, the
prince of the eunuchs brought them in
before Nebuchadnezzar.
19 The king talked with them; and
among them all was found no one like
Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah.
Therefore they stood before the king.
20 In every matter of wisdom and
understanding concerning which the king
inquired of them, he found them ten
times better than all the magicians and
enchanters who were in all his realm.
21 Daniel continued even to the first
year of King Cyrus.

2

1 In the second year of the reign of
Nebuchadnezzar, Nebuchadnezzar

† **1:2** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." ‡ **1:2** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). § **1:3** or, seed

dreamed dreams; and his spirit was
troubled, and his sleep went from him.
2 Then the king commanded that the
magicians, the enchanters, the sorcerers,
and the Chaldeans be called to tell the
king his dreams. So they came in and
stood before the king.
3 The king said to them, “I have
dreamed a dream, and my spirit is
troubled to know the dream.”
4 Then the Chaldeans spoke to the king
in the Syrian language, “O king, live
forever! Tell your servants the dream,
and we will show the interpretation.”
5 The king answered the Chaldeans,
“The thing has gone from me. If you don’t
make known to me the dream and its
interpretation, you will be cut in pieces,
and your houses will be made a dunghill.
6 But if you show the dream and its
interpretation, you will receive from me
gifts, rewards, and great honor. Therefore
show me the dream and its
interpretation.”
7 They answered the second time and
said, “Let the king tell his servants the
dream, and we will show the
interpretation.”
8 The king answered, “I know of a
certainty that you are trying to gain time,
because you see the thing has gone from
me.
9 But if you don’t make known to me the
dream, there is but one law for you; for
you have prepared lying and corrupt
words to speak before me, until the
situation changes. Therefore tell me the
dream, and I will know that you can show
me its interpretation.”
10 The Chaldeans answered the king and
said, “There is not a man on the earth who
can show the king’s matter, because no
king, lord, or ruler has asked such a thing
of any magician, enchanter, or Chaldean.
11 It is a rare thing that the king
requires, and there is no other who can
show it before the king except the gods,
whose dwelling is not with flesh.”
12 Because of this, the king was angry
and very furious, and commanded that all
the wise men of Babylon be destroyed.
13 So the decree went out, and the wise
men were to be slain. They sought Daniel
and his companions to be slain.
14 Then Daniel returned answer with
counsel and prudence to Arioch the
captain of the king’s guard, who had gone
out to kill the wise men of Babylon.
15 He answered Arioch the king’s
captain, “Why is the decree so urgent
from the king?” Then Arioch made the
thing known to Daniel.
16 Daniel went in, and desired of the
king that he would appoint him a time,
and he would show the king the
interpretation.
17 Then Daniel went to his house and
made the thing known to Hananiah,
Mishael, and Azariah, his companions:
18 that they would desire mercies of the
God of heaven concerning this secret, that
Daniel and his companions would not
perish with the rest of the wise men of
Babylon.
19 Then the secret was revealed to
Daniel in a vision of the night. Then
Daniel blessed the God of heaven.
20 Daniel answered,
“Blessed be the name of God forever and
ever;
for wisdom and might are his.
21 He changes the times and the seasons.
He removes kings and sets up kings.
He gives wisdom to the wise,
and knowledge to those who have
understanding.
22 He reveals the deep and secret things.
He knows what is in the darkness,
and the light dwells with him.
23 I thank you and praise you,
O God of my fathers,
who have given me wisdom and might,
and have now made known to me
what we desired of you;
for you have made known to us the
king’s matter.”
24 Therefore Daniel went in to Arioch,
whom the king had appointed to destroy
the wise men of Babylon. He went and
said this to him: “Don’t destroy the wise
men of Babylon. Bring me in before the
king, and I will show to the king the
interpretation.”

25 Then Arioch brought in Daniel before
the king in haste, and said this to him: "I
have found a man of the children of the
captivity of Judah who will make known
to the king the interpretation."
26 The king answered Daniel, whose
name was Belteshazzar, "Are you able to
make known to me the dream which I
have seen, and its interpretation?"
27 Daniel answered before the king, and
said, "The secret which the king has
demanded can't be shown to the king by
wise men, enchanters, magicians, or
soothsayers;
28 but there is a God in heaven who
reveals secrets, and he has made known
to King Nebuchadnezzar what will be in
the latter days. Your dream and the
visions of your head on your bed are
these:
29 "As for you, O king, your thoughts
came on your bed, what should happen
hereafter; and he who reveals secrets has
made known to you what will happen.
30 But as for me, this secret is not
revealed to me for any wisdom that I have
more than any living, but to the intent
that the interpretation may be made
known to the king, and that you may
know the thoughts of your heart.
31 "You, O king, saw, and behold,† a
great image. This image, which was
mighty, and whose brightness was
excellent, stood before you; and its
appearance was terrifying.
32 As for this image, its head was of fine
gold, its chest and its arms of silver, its
belly and its thighs of bronze,
33 its legs of iron, its feet part of iron and
part of clay.
34 You saw until a stone was cut out
without hands, which struck the image on
its feet that were of iron and clay, and
broke them in pieces.
35 Then the iron, the clay, the bronze,
the silver, and the gold were broken in
pieces together, and became like the chaff
of the summer threshing floors. The wind
carried them away, so that no place was
found for them. The stone that struck the
image became a great mountain and filled
the whole earth.
36 "This is the dream; and we will tell its
interpretation before the king.
37 You, O king, are king of kings, to
whom the God of heaven has given the
kingdom, the power, the strength, and the
glory.
38 Wherever the children of men dwell,
he has given the animals of the field and
the birds of the sky into your hand, and
has made you rule over them all. You are
the head of gold.
39 "After you, another kingdom will
arise that is inferior to you; and another
third kingdom of bronze, which will rule
over all the earth.
40 The fourth kingdom will be strong as
iron, because iron breaks in pieces and
subdues all things; and as iron that
crushes all these, it will break in pieces
and crush.
41 Whereas you saw the feet and toes,
part of potters' clay and part of iron, it will
be a divided kingdom; but there will be in
it of the strength of the iron, because you
saw the iron mixed with miry clay.
42 As the toes of the feet were part of
iron, and part of clay, so the kingdom will
be partly strong and partly brittle.
43 Whereas you saw the iron mixed with
miry clay, they will mingle themselves
with the seed of men; but they won't cling
to one another, even as iron does not mix
with clay.
44 "In the days of those kings the God of
heaven will set up a kingdom which will
never be destroyed, nor will its
sovereignty be left to another people; but
it will break in pieces and consume all
these kingdoms, and it will stand forever.
45 Because you saw that a stone was cut
out of the mountain without hands, and
that it broke in pieces the iron, the bronze,
the clay, the silver, and the gold, the great
God has made known to the king what
will happen hereafter. The dream is
certain, and its interpretation sure."

† **2:31** "Behold", from "הֲנָה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

46 Then King Nebuchadnezzar fell on
his face, worshiped Daniel, and
commanded that they should offer an
offering and sweet odors to him.
47 The king answered to Daniel, and
said, “Of a truth your God is the God of
gods, and the Lord of kings, and a revealer
of secrets, since you have been able to
reveal this secret.”
48 Then the king made Daniel great and
gave him many great gifts, and made him
rule over the whole province of Babylon
and to be chief governor over all the wise
men of Babylon.
49 Daniel requested of the king, and he
appointed Shadrach, Meshach, and
Abednego over the affairs of the province
of Babylon, but Daniel was in the king’s
gate.

3

1 Nebuchadnezzar the king made an
image of gold, whose height was sixty
cubits† and its width six cubits. He set it
up in the plain of Dura, in the province of
Babylon.
2 Then Nebuchadnezzar the king sent to
gather together the local governors, the
deputies, and the governors, the judges,
the treasurers, the counselors, the
sheriffs, and all the rulers of the
provinces, to come to the dedication of the
image which Nebuchadnezzar the king
had set up.
3 Then the local governors, the deputies,
and the governors, the judges, the
treasurers, the counselors, the sheriffs,
and all the rulers of the provinces were
gathered together to the dedication of the
image that Nebuchadnezzar the king had
set up; and they stood before the image
that Nebuchadnezzar had set up.
4 Then the herald cried aloud, “To you it
is commanded, peoples, nations, and
languages,
5 that whenever you hear the sound of
the horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, pipe,
and all kinds of music, you fall down and
worship the golden image that
Nebuchadnezzar the king has set up.
6 Whoever doesn’t fall down and
worship shall be cast into the middle of a
burning fiery furnace the same hour.”
7 Therefore at that time, when all the
peoples heard the sound of the horn, flute,
zither, lyre, harp, pipe, and all kinds of
music, all the peoples, the nations, and the
languages fell down and worshiped the
golden image that Nebuchadnezzar the
king had set up.
8 Therefore at that time certain
Chaldeans came near and brought
accusation against the Jews.
9 They answered Nebuchadnezzar the
king, “O king, live for ever!
10 You, O king, have made a decree that
every man who hears the sound of the
horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, pipe, and all
kinds of music shall fall down and
worship the golden image;
11 and whoever doesn’t fall down and
worship shall be cast into the middle of a
burning fiery furnace.
12 There are certain Jews whom you
have appointed over the affairs of the
province of Babylon: Shadrach, Meshach,
and Abednego. These men, O king, have
not respected you. They don’t serve your
gods, and don’t worship the golden image
which you have set up.”
13 Then Nebuchadnezzar in rage and
fury commanded that Shadrach,
Meshach, and Abednego be brought. Then
these men were brought before the king.
14 Nebuchadnezzar answered them, “Is
it true, Shadrach, Meshach, and
Abednego, that you don’t serve my gods
and you don’t worship the golden image
which I have set up?
15 Now if you are ready whenever you
hear the sound of the horn, flute, zither,
lyre, harp, pipe, and all kinds of music to
fall down and worship the image which I
have made, good; but if you don’t
worship, you shall be cast the same hour
into the middle of a burning fiery furnace.

† **3:1** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

Who is that god who will deliver you out of my hands?"

16 Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego answered the king, "Nebuchadnezzar, we have no need to answer you in this matter.

17 If it happens, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace; and he will deliver us out of your hand, O king.

18 But if not, let it be known to you, O king, that we will not serve your gods or worship the golden image which you have set up."

19 Then Nebuchadnezzar was full of fury, and the form of his appearance was changed against Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. He spoke, and commanded that they should heat the furnace seven times more than it was usually heated.

20 He commanded certain mighty men who were in his army to bind Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, and to cast them into the burning fiery furnace.

21 Then these men were bound in their pants, their tunics, and their mantles, and their other clothes, and were cast into the middle of the burning fiery furnace.

22 Therefore because the king's commandment was urgent and the furnace exceedingly hot, the flame of the fire killed those men who took up Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego.

23 These three men, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, fell down bound into the middle of the burning fiery furnace.

24 Then Nebuchadnezzar the king was astonished and rose up in haste. He spoke and said to his counselors, "Didn't we cast three men bound into the middle of the fire?"

They answered the king, "True, O king."

25 He answered, "Look, I see four men loose, walking in the middle of the fire, and they are unharmed. The appearance of the fourth is like a son of the gods.‡"

26 Then Nebuchadnezzar came near to the mouth of the burning fiery furnace. He spoke and said, "Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, you servants of the Most High God, come out, and come here!"

Then Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego came out of the middle of the fire.

27 The local governors, the deputies, and the governors, and the king's counselors, being gathered together, saw these men, that the fire had no power on their bodies. The hair of their head wasn't singed. Their pants weren't changed. The smell of fire wasn't even on them.

28 Nebuchadnezzar spoke and said, "Blessed be the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, who has sent his angel and delivered his servants who trusted in him, and have changed the king's word, and have yielded their bodies, that they might not serve nor worship any god except their own God.

29 Therefore I make a decree that every people, nation, and language which speak anything evil against the God of Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego shall be cut in pieces, and their houses shall be made a dunghill, because there is no other god who is able to deliver like this."

30 Then the king promoted Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego in the province of Babylon.

4

1 Nebuchadnezzar the king,
to all the peoples, nations, and languages, who dwell in all the earth:
Peace be multiplied to you.

2 It has seemed good to me to show the signs and wonders that the Most High God has worked toward me.

3 How great are his signs!
How mighty are his wonders!
His kingdom is an everlasting kingdom.
His dominion is from generation to generation.

4 I, Nebuchadnezzar, was at rest in my house, and flourishing in my palace.

5 I saw a dream which made me afraid; and the thoughts on my bed and the visions of my head troubled me.

6 Therefore I made a decree to bring in all the wise men of Babylon before me,

‡ **3:25** Or, the Son of God.

that they might make known to me the interpretation of the dream.
7 Then the magicians, the enchanters, the Chaldeans, and the soothsayers came in; and I told them the dream, but they didn't make known to me its interpretation.
8 But at last, Daniel came in before me, whose name was Belteshazzar according to the name of my god, and in whom is the spirit of the holy gods. I told the dream before him, saying,
9 "Belteshazzar, master of the magicians, because I know that the spirit of the holy gods is in you and no secret troubles you, tell me the visions of my dream that I have seen, and its interpretation.
10 These were the visions of my head on my bed: I saw, and behold, a tree in the middle of the earth; and its height was great.
11 The tree grew and was strong. Its height reached to the sky and its sight to the end of all the earth.
12 Its leaves were beautiful, and it had much fruit, and in it was food for all. The animals of the field had shade under it, and the birds of the sky lived in its branches, and all flesh was fed from it.
13 "I saw in the visions of my head on my bed, and behold, a holy watcher came down from the sky.
14 He cried aloud and said this: 'Cut down the tree, and cut off its branches! Shake off its leaves and scatter its fruit! Let the animals get away from under it and the birds from its branches.
15 Nevertheless leave the stump of its roots in the earth, even with a band of iron and bronze, in the tender grass of the field; and let it be wet with the dew of the sky. Let his portion be with the animals in the grass of the earth.
16 Let his heart be changed from man's, and let an animal's heart be given to him. Then let seven times pass over him.
17 " 'The sentence is by the decree of the watchers and the demand by the word of the holy ones, to the intent that the living may know that the Most High rules in the kingdom of men, and gives it to whomever he will, and sets up over it the lowest of men.'
18 "This dream I, King Nebuchadnezzar, have seen; and you, Belteshazzar, declare the interpretation, because all the wise men of my kingdom are not able to make known to me the interpretation; but you are able, for the spirit of the holy gods is in you."
19 Then Daniel, whose name was Belteshazzar, was stricken mute for a while, and his thoughts troubled him. The king answered, "Belteshazzar, don't let the dream or the interpretation, trouble you."
Belteshazzar answered, "My lord, may the dream be for those who hate you, and its interpretation to your adversaries.
20 The tree that you saw, which grew and was strong, whose height reached to the sky and its sight to all the earth;
21 whose leaves were beautiful and its fruit plentiful, and in it was food for all; under which the animals of the field lived, and on whose branches the birds of the sky had their habitation—
22 it is you, O king, that have grown and become strong; for your greatness has grown, and reaches to the sky, and your dominion to the end of the earth.
23 "Whereas the king saw a holy watcher coming down from the sky and saying, 'Cut down the tree, and destroy it; nevertheless leave the stump of its roots in the earth, even with a band of iron and bronze, in the tender grass of the field, and let it be wet with the dew of the sky. Let his portion be with the animals of the field, until seven times pass over him.'
24 "This is the interpretation, O king, and it is the decree of the Most High, which has come on my lord the king:
25 You will be driven from men and your dwelling shall be with the animals of the field. You will be made to eat grass as oxen, and will be wet with the dew of the sky, and seven times shall pass over you, until you know that the Most High rules in

the kingdom of men, and gives it to
whomever he will.
26 Whereas it was commanded to
leave the stump of the roots of the tree,
your kingdom shall be sure to you after
you know that Heaven rules.
27 Therefore, O king, let my counsel be
acceptable to you, and break off your sins
by righteousness, and your iniquities by
showing mercy to the poor. Perhaps there
may be a lengthening of your tranquility."
28 All this came on the King
Nebuchadnezzar.
29 At the end of twelve months he was
walking in the royal palace of Babylon.
30 The king spoke and said, "Is not this
great Babylon, which I have built for the
royal dwelling place by the might of my
power and for the glory of my majesty?"
31 While the word was in the king's
mouth, a voice came from the sky,
saying, "O King Nebuchadnezzar, to you
it is spoken: 'The kingdom has departed
from you.
32 You shall be driven from men, and
your dwelling shall be with the animals of
the field. You shall be made to eat grass
like oxen. Seven times shall pass over you,
until you know that the Most High rules in
the kingdom of men, and gives it to
whomever he will.' "
33 This was fulfilled the same hour on
Nebuchadnezzar. He was driven from
men and ate grass like oxen; and his
body was wet with the dew of the sky
until his hair had grown like eagles'
feathers, and his nails like birds' claws.
34 At the end of the days I,
Nebuchadnezzar, lifted up my eyes to
heaven, and my understanding
returned to me; and I blessed the Most
High, and I praised and honored him
who lives forever,

for his dominion is an everlasting
dominion,
and his kingdom from generation to
generation.

35 All the inhabitants of the earth are
reputed as nothing;
and he does according to his will in
the army of heaven,
and among the inhabitants of the
earth;
and no one can stop his hand,
or ask him, "What are you doing?"
36 At the same time my understanding
returned to me; and for the glory of my
kingdom, my majesty and brightness
returned to me. My counselors and my
lords sought me; and I was established
in my kingdom, and excellent greatness
was added to me.
37 Now I, Nebuchadnezzar, praise and
extol and honor the King of heaven; for all
his works are truth, and his ways justice;
and those who walk in pride he is able to
abase.

5

1 Belshazzar the king made a great feast
to a thousand of his lords, and drank wine
before the thousand.
2 Belshazzar, while he tasted the wine,
commanded that the golden and silver
vessels which Nebuchadnezzar his father
had taken out of the temple which was in
Jerusalem be brought to him, that the king
and his lords, his wives and his
concubines, might drink from them.
3 Then they brought the golden vessels
that were taken out of the temple of God's
house which was at Jerusalem; and the
king and his lords, his wives and his
concubines, drank from them.
4 They drank wine, and praised the gods
of gold, and of silver, of bronze, of iron, of
wood, and of stone.
5 In the same hour, the fingers of a
man's hand came out and wrote near the
lamp stand on the plaster of the wall of
the king's palace. The king saw the part of
the hand that wrote.
6 Then the king's face was changed in
him, and his thoughts troubled him; and
the joints of his thighs were loosened, and
his knees struck one against another.
7 The king cried aloud to bring in the
enchanters, the Chaldeans, and the
soothsayers. The king spoke and said to
the wise men of Babylon, "Whoever reads
this writing and shows me its
interpretation shall be clothed with
purple, and have a chain of gold about his

neck, and shall be the third ruler in the kingdom."

8 Then all the king's wise men came in; but they could not read the writing, and couldn't make known to the king the interpretation.

9 Then King Belshazzar was greatly troubled, and his face was changed in him, and his lords were perplexed.

10 The queen by reason of the words of the king and his lords came into the banquet house. The queen spoke and said, "O king, live forever; don't let your thoughts trouble you, nor let your face be changed.

11 There is a man in your kingdom in whom is the spirit of the holy gods; and in the days of your father, light and understanding and wisdom, like the wisdom of the gods, were found in him. The king, Nebuchadnezzar, your father—yes, the king, your father—made him master of the magicians, enchanters, Chaldeans, and soothsayers,

12 because an excellent spirit, knowledge, understanding, interpreting of dreams, showing of dark sentences, and dissolving of doubts were found in the same Daniel, whom the king named Belteshazzar. Now let Daniel be called, and he will show the interpretation."

13 Then Daniel was brought in before the king. The king spoke and said to Daniel, "Are you that Daniel of the children of the captivity of Judah, whom the king my father brought out of Judah?

14 I have heard of you, that the spirit of the gods is in you and that light, understanding, and excellent wisdom are found in you.

15 Now the wise men, the enchanters, have been brought in before me, that they should read this writing, and make known to me its interpretation; but they could not show the interpretation of the thing.

16 But I have heard of you, that you can give interpretations and dissolve doubts. Now if you can read the writing and make known to me its interpretation, you shall be clothed with purple, and have a chain of gold around your neck, and shall be the third ruler in the kingdom."

17 Then Daniel answered before the king, "Let your gifts be to yourself, and give your rewards to another. Nevertheless, I will read the writing to the king, and make known to him the interpretation.

18 "To you, king, the Most High God gave Nebuchadnezzar your father the kingdom, and greatness, and glory, and majesty.

19 Because of the greatness that he gave him, all the peoples, nations, and languages trembled and feared before him. He killed whom he wanted to, and he kept alive whom he wanted to. He raised up whom he wanted to, and he put down whom he wanted to.

20 But when his heart was lifted up, and his spirit was hardened so that he dealt proudly, he was deposed from his kingly throne, and they took his glory from him.

21 He was driven from the sons of men, and his heart was made like the animals', and his dwelling was with the wild donkeys. He was fed with grass like oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of the sky, until he knew that the Most High God rules in the kingdom of men, and that he sets up over it whomever he will.

22 "You, his son, Belshazzar, have not humbled your heart, though you knew all this,

23 but have lifted up yourself against the Lord of heaven; and they have brought the vessels of his house before you, and you and your lords, your wives, and your concubines, have drunk wine from them. You have praised the gods of silver and gold, of bronze, iron, wood, and stone, which don't see, or hear, or know; and you have not glorified the God in whose hand your breath is, and whose are all your ways.

24 Then the part of the hand was sent from before him, and this writing was inscribed.

25 "This is the writing that was inscribed: 'MENE, MENE, TEKEL, UPHARSIN.'

26 “This is the interpretation of the thing:
MENE: God has counted your kingdom, and brought it to an end.
27 TEKEL: you are weighed in the balances, and are found wanting.
28 PERES: your kingdom is divided, and given to the Medes and Persians.”
29 Then Belshazzar commanded, and they clothed Daniel with purple, and put a chain of gold about his neck, and made proclamation concerning him, that he should be the third ruler in the kingdom.
30 In that night Belshazzar the Chaldean King was slain.
31 Darius the Mede received the kingdom, being about sixty-two years old.

6

1 It pleased Darius to set over the kingdom one hundred twenty local governors, who should be throughout the whole kingdom;
2 and over them three presidents, of whom Daniel was one, that these local governors might give account to them, and that the king should suffer no loss.
3 Then this Daniel was distinguished above the presidents and the local governors, because an excellent spirit was in him; and the king thought to set him over the whole realm.
4 Then the presidents and the local governors sought to find occasion against Daniel as touching the kingdom; but they could find no occasion or fault, because he was faithful. There wasn’t any error or fault found in him.
5 Then these men said, “We won’t find any occasion against this Daniel, unless we find it against him concerning the law of his God.”
6 Then these presidents and local governors assembled together to the king, and said this to him, “King Darius, live forever!
7 All the presidents of the kingdom, the deputies and the local governors, the counselors and the governors, have consulted together to establish a royal statute and to make a strong decree, that whoever asks a petition of any god or man for thirty days, except of you, O king, he shall be cast into the den of lions.
8 Now, O king, establish the decree and sign the writing, that it not be changed, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, which doesn’t alter.”
9 Therefore King Darius signed the writing and the decree.
10 When Daniel knew that the writing was signed, he went into his house (now his windows were open in his room toward Jerusalem) and he kneeled on his knees three times a day, and prayed, and gave thanks before his God, as he did before.
11 Then these men assembled together, and found Daniel making petition and supplication before his God.
12 Then they came near, and spoke before the king concerning the king’s decree: “Haven’t you signed a decree that every man who makes a petition to any god or man within thirty days, except to you, O king, shall be cast into the den of lions?”
The king answered, “This thing is true, according to the law of the Medes and Persians, which doesn’t alter.”
13 Then they answered and said before the king, “That Daniel, who is of the children of the captivity of Judah, doesn’t respect you, O king, nor the decree that you have signed, but makes his petition three times a day.”
14 Then the king, when he heard these words, was very displeased, and set his heart on Daniel to deliver him; and he labored until the going down of the sun to rescue him.
15 Then these men assembled together to the king, and said to the king, “Know, O king, that it is a law of the Medes and Persians, that no decree nor statute which the king establishes may be changed.”
16 Then the king commanded, and they brought Daniel and cast him into the den of lions. The king spoke and said to Daniel, “Your God whom you serve continually, he will deliver you.”
17 A stone was brought, and laid on the mouth of the den; and the king sealed it

with his own signet, and with the signet of his lords; that nothing might be changed concerning Daniel.
18 Then the king went to his palace, and passed the night fasting. No musical instruments were brought before him; and his sleep fled from him.
19 Then the king arose very early in the morning, and went in haste to the den of lions.
20 When he came near to the den to Daniel, he cried with a troubled voice. The king spoke and said to Daniel, "Daniel, servant of the living God, is your God, whom you serve continually, able to deliver you from the lions?"
21 Then Daniel said to the king, "O king, live forever!
22 My God has sent his angel, and has shut the lions' mouths, and they have not hurt me, because innocence was found in me before him; and also before you, O king, I have done no harm."
23 Then the king was exceedingly glad, and commanded that they should take Daniel up out of the den. So Daniel was taken up out of the den, and no kind of harm was found on him, because he had trusted in his God.
24 The king commanded, and they brought those men who had accused Daniel, and they cast them into the den of lions—them, their children, and their wives; and the lions mauled them, and broke all their bones in pieces before they came to the bottom of the den.
25 Then King Darius wrote to all the peoples, nations, and languages who dwell in all the earth:
"Peace be multiplied to you.
26 "I make a decree that in all the dominion of my kingdom men tremble and fear before the God of Daniel.
"For he is the living God,
and steadfast forever.
His kingdom is that which will not be destroyed.
His dominion will be even to the end.
27 He delivers and rescues.
He works signs and wonders in heaven and in earth,
who has delivered Daniel from the power of the lions."
28 So this Daniel prospered in the reign of Darius and in the reign of Cyrus the Persian.

7

1 In the first year of Belshazzar king of Babylon, Daniel had a dream and visions of his head while on his bed. Then he wrote the dream and told the sum of the matters.
2 Daniel spoke and said, "I saw in my vision by night, and, behold, the four winds of the sky broke out on the great sea.
3 Four great animals came up from the sea, different from one another.
4 "The first was like a lion, and had eagle's wings. I watched until its wings were plucked, and it was lifted up from the earth and made to stand on two feet as a man. A man's heart was given to it.
5 "Behold, there was another animal, a second, like a bear. It was raised up on one side, and three ribs were in its mouth between its teeth. They said this to it: 'Arise! Devour much flesh!'
6 "After this I saw, and behold, another, like a leopard, which had on its back four wings of a bird. The animal also had four heads; and dominion was given to it.
7 "After this I saw in the night visions, and, behold, there was a fourth animal, awesome, powerful, and exceedingly strong. It had great iron teeth. It devoured and broke in pieces, and stamped the residue with its feet. It was different from all the animals that were before it. It had ten horns.
8 "I considered the horns, and behold, there came up among them another horn, a little one, before which three of the first horns were plucked up by the roots; and behold, in this horn were eyes like the eyes of a man, and a mouth speaking arrogantly.
9 "I watched until thrones were placed,
and one who was Ancient of Days sat.
His clothing was white as snow,
and the hair of his head like pure wool.
His throne was fiery flames,
and its wheels burning fire.

10 A fiery stream issued and came out
from before him.
Thousands of thousands ministered
to him.
Ten thousand times ten thousand
stood before him.
The judgment was set.
The books were opened.
11 "I watched at that time because of the
voice of the arrogant words which the
horn spoke. I watched even until the
animal was slain, and its body destroyed,
and it was given to be burned with fire.
12 As for the rest of the animals, their
dominion was taken away; yet their lives
were prolonged for a season and a time.
13 "I saw in the night visions, and
behold, there came with the clouds of the
sky one like a son of man, and he came
even to the Ancient of Days, and they
brought him near before him.
14 Dominion was given him, and glory,
and a kingdom, that all the peoples,
nations, and languages should serve him.
His dominion is an everlasting dominion,
which will not pass away, and his
kingdom one that will not be destroyed.
15 "As for me, Daniel, my spirit was
grieved within my body, and the visions
of my head troubled me.
16 I came near to one of those who stood
by, and asked him the truth concerning all
this.
"So he told me, and made me know the
interpretation of the things.
17 'These great animals, which are four,
are four kings, who will arise out of the
earth.
18 But the saints of the Most High will
receive the kingdom, and possess the
kingdom forever, even forever and ever.'
19 "Then I desired to know the truth
concerning the fourth animal, which was
different from all of them, exceedingly
terrible, whose teeth were of iron, and its
nails of bronze; which devoured, broke in
pieces, and stamped the residue with its
feet;
20 and concerning the ten horns that
were on its head and the other horn
which came up, and before which three
fell, even that horn that had eyes and a
mouth that spoke arrogantly, whose look
was more stout than its fellows.
21 I saw, and the same horn made war
with the saints, and prevailed against
them,
22 until the Ancient of Days came, and
judgment was given to the saints of the
Most High, and the time came that the
saints possessed the kingdom.
23 "So he said, 'The fourth animal will be
a fourth kingdom on earth, which will be
different from all the kingdoms, and will
devour the whole earth, and will tread it
down and break it in pieces.
24 As for the ten horns, ten kings will
arise out of this kingdom. Another will
arise after them; and he will be different
from the former, and he will put down
three kings.
25 He will speak words against the Most
High, and will wear out the saints of the
Most High. He will plan to change the
times and the law; and they will be given
into his hand until a time and times and
half a time.
26 " 'But the judgment will be set, and
they will take away his dominion, to
consume and to destroy it to the end.
27 The kingdom and the dominion, and
the greatness of the kingdoms under the
whole sky, will be given to the people of
the saints of the Most High. His kingdom
is an everlasting kingdom, and all
dominions will serve and obey him.'
28 "Here is the end of the matter. As for
me, Daniel, my thoughts troubled me
greatly, and my face was changed in me;
but I kept the matter in my heart."

8

1 In the third year of the reign of King
Belshazzar, a vision appeared to me, even
to me, Daniel, after that which appeared
to me at the first.
2 I saw the vision. Now it was so, that
when I saw, I was in the citadel of Susa,
which is in the province of Elam. I saw in
the vision, and I was by the river Ulai.
3 Then I lifted up my eyes and saw, and
behold, a ram which had two horns stood
before the river. The two horns were

high, but one was higher than the other, and the higher came up last.
4 I saw the ram pushing westward, northward, and southward. No animals could stand before him. There wasn't any who could deliver out of his hand, but he did according to his will, and magnified himself.
5 As I was considering, behold, a male goat came from the west over the surface of the whole earth, and didn't touch the ground. The goat had a notable horn between his eyes.
6 He came to the ram that had the two horns, which I saw standing before the river, and ran on him in the fury of his power.
7 I saw him come close to the ram, and he was moved with anger against him, and struck the ram, and broke his two horns. There was no power in the ram to stand before him; but he cast him down to the ground and trampled on him. There was no one who could deliver the ram out of his hand.
8 The male goat magnified himself exceedingly. When he was strong, the great horn was broken; and instead of it there came up four notable horns toward the four winds of the sky.
9 Out of one of them came out a little horn which grew exceedingly great—toward the south, and toward the east, and toward the glorious land.
10 It grew great, even to the army of the sky; and it cast down some of the army and of the stars to the ground and trampled on them.
11 Yes, it magnified itself, even to the prince of the army; and it took away from him the continual burnt offering, and the place of his sanctuary was cast down.
12 The army was given over to it together with the continual burnt offering through disobedience. It cast down truth to the ground, and it did its pleasure and prospered.
13 Then I heard a holy one speaking; and another holy one said to that certain one who spoke, "How long will the vision about the continual burnt offering, and the disobedience that makes desolate, to give both the sanctuary and the army to be trodden under foot be?"
14 He said to me, "To two thousand and three hundred evenings and mornings. Then the sanctuary will be cleansed."
15 When I, even I Daniel, had seen the vision, I sought to understand it. Then behold, there stood before me someone with the appearance of a man.
16 I heard a man's voice between the banks of the Ulai, which called and said, "Gabriel, make this man understand the vision."
17 So he came near where I stood; and when he came, I was frightened, and fell on my face; but he said to me, "Understand, son of man, for the vision belongs to the time of the end."
18 Now as he was speaking with me, I fell into a deep sleep with my face toward the ground; but he touched me and set me upright.
19 He said, "Behold, I will make you know what will be in the latter time of the indignation, for it belongs to the appointed time of the end.
20 The ram which you saw, that had the two horns, they are the kings of Media and Persia.
21 The rough male goat is the king of Greece. The great horn that is between his eyes is the first king.
22 As for that which was broken, in the place where four stood up, four kingdoms will stand up out of the nation, but not with his power.
23 "In the latter time of their kingdom, when the transgressors have come to the full, a king of fierce face, and understanding riddles, will stand up.
24 His power will be mighty, but not by his own power. He will destroy awesomely, and will prosper in what he does. He will destroy the mighty ones and the holy people.
25 Through his policy he will cause deceit to prosper in his hand. He will magnify himself in his heart, and he will destroy many in their security. He will also stand up against the prince of princes, but he will be broken without human hands.

26 “The vision of the evenings and
mornings which has been told is true; but
seal up the vision, for it belongs to many
days to come.”
27 I, Daniel, fainted, and was sick for
some days. Then I rose up and did the
king’s business. I wondered at the vision,
but no one understood it.

9

1 In the first year of Darius the son of
Ahasuerus, of the offspring of the Medes,
who was made king over the realm of the
Chaldeans—
2 in the first year of his reign I, Daniel,
understood by the books the number of
the years about which Yahweh’s† word
came to Jeremiah the prophet for the
accomplishing of the desolations of
Jerusalem, even seventy years.
3 I set my face to the Lord God, to seek
by prayer and petitions, with fasting and
sackcloth and ashes.
4 I prayed to Yahweh my God, and made
confession, and said,
“Oh, Lord, the great and dreadful
God, who keeps covenant and loving
kindness with those who love him and
keep his commandments,
5 we have sinned, and have dealt
perversely, and have done wickedly, and
have rebelled, even turning aside from
your precepts and from your ordinances.
6 We haven’t listened to your servants
the prophets, who spoke in your name to
our kings, our princes, and our fathers,
and to all the people of the land.
7 “Lord, righteousness belongs to you,
but to us confusion of face, as it is today;
to the men of Judah, and to the
inhabitants of Jerusalem, and to all
Israel, who are near and who are far off,
through all the countries where you
have driven them, because of their
trespass that they have trespassed
against you.
8 Lord, to us belongs confusion of
face, to our kings, to our princes, and to
our fathers, because we have sinned
against you.
9 To the Lord our God belong mercies
and forgiveness, for we have rebelled
against him.
10 We haven’t obeyed Yahweh our
God’s voice, to walk in his laws, which he
set before us by his servants the prophets.
11 Yes, all Israel have transgressed
your law, turning aside, that they should
not obey your voice.
“Therefore the curse and the oath
written in the law of Moses the servant
of God has been poured out on us, for
we have sinned against him.
12 He has confirmed his words, which
he spoke against us and against our judges
who judged us, by bringing on us a great
evil; for under the whole sky, such has not
been done as has been done to Jerusalem.
13 As it is written in the law of Moses,
all this evil has come on us. Yet we have
not entreated the favor of Yahweh our
God, that we should turn from our
iniquities and have discernment in your
truth.
14 Therefore Yahweh has watched
over the evil, and brought it on us; for
Yahweh our God is righteous in all his
works which he does, and we have not
obeyed his voice.
15 “Now, Lord our God, who has
brought your people out of the land of
Egypt with a mighty hand, and have
gotten yourself renown, as it is today,
we have sinned. We have done
wickedly.
16 Lord, according to all your
righteousness, please let your anger and
your wrath be turned away from your city
Jerusalem, your holy mountain; because
for our sins and for the iniquities of our
fathers, Jerusalem and your people have
become a reproach to all who are around
us.
17 “Now therefore, our God, listen to
the prayer of your servant and to his
petitions, and cause your face to shine
on your sanctuary that is desolate, for
the Lord’s sake.
18 My God, turn your ear and hear.
Open your eyes and see our desolations,
and the city which is called by your name;

† **9:2** “Yahweh” is God’s proper Name, sometimes rendered “LORD” (all caps) in other translations.

for we do not present our petitions before you for our righteousness, but for your great mercies' sake.
19 Lord, hear. Lord, forgive. Lord, listen and do. Don't defer, for your own sake, my God, because your city and your people are called by your name."

20 While I was speaking, praying, and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel, and presenting my supplication before Yahweh my God for the holy mountain of my God—
21 yes, while I was speaking in prayer—the man Gabriel, whom I had seen in the vision at the beginning, being caused to fly swiftly, touched me about the time of the evening offering.
22 He instructed me and talked with me, and said, "Daniel, I have now come to give you wisdom and understanding.
23 At the beginning of your petitions the commandment went out, and I have come to tell you, for you are greatly beloved. Therefore consider the matter and understand the vision.
24 "Seventy weeks are decreed on your people and on your holy city, to finish disobedience, to make an end of sins, to make reconciliation for iniquity, to bring in everlasting righteousness, to seal up vision and prophecy, and to anoint the most holy.
25 "Know therefore and discern that from the going out of the commandment to restore and build Jerusalem to the Anointed One,‡ the prince, will be seven weeks and sixty-two weeks. It will be built again, with street and moat, even in troubled times.
26 After the sixty-two weeks the Anointed One§ will be cut off, and will have nothing. The people of the prince who come will destroy the city and the sanctuary. Its end will be with a flood, and war will be even to the end. Desolations are determined.
27 He will make a firm covenant with many for one week. In the middle of the week he will cause the sacrifice and the offering to cease. On the wing of abominations will come one who makes desolate; and even to the decreed full end, wrath will be poured out on the desolate."

10

1 In the third year of Cyrus king of Persia a message was revealed to Daniel, whose name was called Belteshazzar; and the message was true, even a great warfare. He understood the message, and had understanding of the vision.
2 In those days I, Daniel, was mourning three whole weeks.
3 I ate no pleasant food. No meat or wine came into my mouth. I didn't anoint myself at all, until three whole weeks were fulfilled.
4 In the twenty-fourth day of the first month, as I was by the side of the great river, which is Hiddekel,†
5 I lifted up my eyes and looked, and behold, there was a man clothed in linen, whose waist was adorned with pure gold of Uphaz.
6 His body also was like beryl, and his face as the appearance of lightning, and his eyes as flaming torches. His arms and his feet were like burnished bronze. The voice of his words was like the voice of a multitude.
7 I, Daniel, alone saw the vision, for the men who were with me didn't see the vision, but a great quaking fell on them, and they fled to hide themselves.
8 So I was left alone and saw this great vision. No strength remained in me; for my face grew deathly pale, and I retained no strength.
9 Yet I heard the voice of his words. When I heard the voice of his words, then I fell into a deep sleep on my face, with my face toward the ground.
10 Behold, a hand touched me, which set me on my knees and on the palms of my hands.
11 He said to me, "Daniel, you greatly beloved man, understand the words that I speak to you, and stand upright, for I have

‡ **9:25** "Anointed One" can also be translated "Messiah" (same as "Christ"). § **9:26** "Anointed One" can also be translated "Messiah" (same as "Christ"). † **10:4** or, Tigris River

been sent to you, now." When he had spoken this word to me, I stood trembling.
12 Then he said to me, "Don't be afraid, Daniel; for from the first day that you set your heart to understand, and to humble yourself before your God, your words were heard. I have come for your words' sake.
13 But the prince of the kingdom of Persia withstood me twenty-one days; but, behold, Michael, one of the chief princes, came to help me because I remained there with the kings of Persia.
14 Now I have come to make you understand what will happen to your people in the latter days, for the vision is yet for many days."
15 When he had spoken these words to me, I set my face toward the ground and was mute.
16 Behold, one in the likeness of the sons of men touched my lips. Then I opened my mouth, and spoke and said to him who stood before me, "My lord, by reason of the vision my sorrows have overtaken me, and I retain no strength.
17 For how can the servant of this my lord talk with this my lord? For as for me, immediately there remained no strength in me. There was no breath left in me."
18 Then one like the appearance of a man touched me again, and he strengthened me.
19 He said, "Greatly beloved man, don't be afraid. Peace be to you. Be strong. Yes, be strong."
When he spoke to me, I was strengthened, and said, "Let my lord speak, for you have strengthened me."
20 Then he said, "Do you know why I have come to you? Now I will return to fight with the prince of Persia. When I go out, behold, the prince of Greece will come.
21 But I will tell you that which is inscribed in the writing of truth. There is no one who holds with me against these but Michael your prince.

11

1 "As for me, in the first year of Darius the Mede, I stood up to confirm and strengthen him.
2 "Now I will show you the truth. Behold, three more kings will stand up in Persia. The fourth will be far richer than all of them. When he has grown strong through his riches, he will stir up all against the realm of Greece.
3 A mighty king will stand up, who will rule with great dominion, and do according to his will.
4 When he stands up, his kingdom will be broken and will be divided toward the four winds of the sky, but not to his posterity, nor according to his dominion with which he ruled; for his kingdom will be plucked up, even for others besides these.
5 "The king of the south will be strong. One of his princes will become stronger than him, and have dominion. His dominion will be a great dominion.
6 At the end of years they will join themselves together; and the daughter of the king of the south will come to the king of the north to make an agreement, but she will not retain the strength of her arm. He will also not stand, nor will his arm; but she will be given up, with those who brought her, and he who became the father of her, and he who strengthened her in those times.
7 "But out of a shoot from her roots one will stand up in his place, who will come to the army and will enter into the fortress of the king of the north, and will deal against them and will prevail.
8 He will also carry their gods with their molten images, and with their goodly vessels of silver and of gold, captive into Egypt. He will refrain some years from the king of the north.
9 He will come into the realm of the king of the south, but he will return into his own land.
10 His sons will wage war, and will assemble a multitude of great forces which will come on, and overflow, and pass through. They will return and wage war, even to his fortress.
11 "The king of the south will be moved with anger and will come out and fight with him, even with the king of the north.

He will send out a great multitude, and
the multitude will be given into his hand.
12 The multitude will be carried off, and
his heart will be exalted. He will cast
down tens of thousands, but he won't
prevail.
13 The king of the north will return, and
will send out a multitude greater than the
former. He will come on at the end of the
times, even of years, with a great army
and with abundant supplies.
14 "In those times many will stand up
against the king of the south. Also the
children of the violent among your people
will lift themselves up to establish the
vision, but they will fall.
15 So the king of the north will come and
cast up a mound, and take a well-fortified
city. The forces of the south won't stand,
neither will his select troops, neither will
there be any strength to stand.
16 But he who comes against him will do
according to his own will, and no one will
stand before him. He will stand in the
glorious land, and destruction will be in
his hand.
17 He will set his face to come with the
strength of his whole kingdom, and with
him equitable conditions. He will perform
them. He will give him the daughter of
women, to destroy the kingdom, but she
will not stand, and won't be for him.
18 After this he will turn his face to the
islands, and will take many, but a prince
will cause the reproach offered by him to
cease. Yes, moreover, he will cause his
reproach to turn on him.
19 Then he will turn his face toward the
fortresses of his own land; but he will
stumble and fall, and won't be found.
20 "Then one who will cause a tax
collector to pass through the kingdom to
maintain its glory will stand up in his
place; but within few days he shall be
destroyed, not in anger, and not in battle.
21 "In his place a contemptible person
will stand up, to whom they had not given
the honor of the kingdom; but he will
come in time of security, and will obtain
the kingdom by flatteries.
22 The overwhelming forces will be
overwhelmed from before him, and will
be broken. Yes, also the prince of the
covenant.
23 After the treaty made with him he
will work deceitfully; for he will come up
and will become strong with few people.
24 In time of security he will come even
on the fattest places of the province. He
will do that which his fathers have not
done, nor his fathers' fathers. He will
scatter among them prey, plunder, and
wealth. Yes, he will devise his plans
against the strongholds, but only for a
time.
25 "He will stir up his power and his
courage against the king of the south with
a great army; and the king of the south
will wage war in battle with an
exceedingly great and mighty army, but
he won't stand; for they will devise plans
against him.
26 Yes, those who eat of his delicacies
will destroy him, and his army will be
swept away. Many will fall down slain.
27 As for both these kings, their hearts
will be to do evil, and they will speak lies
at one table; but it won't prosper, for the
end will still be at the appointed time.
28 Then he will return into his land with
great wealth. His heart will be against the
holy covenant. He will take action, and
return to his own land.
29 "He will return at the appointed time
and come into the south; but it won't be in
the latter time as it was in the former.
30 For ships of Kittim will come against
him. Therefore he will be grieved, and
will return, and have indignation against
the holy covenant, and will take action.
He will even return, and have regard to
those who forsake the holy covenant.
31 "Forces from him will profane the
sanctuary, even the fortress, and will take
away the continual burnt offering. Then
they will set up the abomination that
makes desolate.
32 He will corrupt those who do
wickedly against the covenant by
flatteries; but the people who know their
God will be strong and take action.
33 "Those who are wise among the
people will instruct many; yet they will

fall by the sword and by flame, by captivity and by plunder, many days.
34 Now when they fall, they will be helped with a little help; but many will join themselves to them with flatteries.
35 Some of those who are wise will fall—to refine them, and to purify, and to make them white, even to the time of the end, because it is yet for the time appointed.

36 "The king will do according to his will. He will exalt himself and magnify himself above every god, and will speak marvelous things against the God of gods. He will prosper until the indignation is accomplished, for that which is determined will be done.
37 He won't regard the gods of his fathers, or the desire of women, or regard any god; for he will magnify himself above all.
38 But in their place, he will honor the god of fortresses. He will honor a god whom his fathers didn't know with gold, silver, and with precious stones and pleasant things.
39 He will deal with the strongest fortresses by the help of a foreign god. He will increase with glory whoever acknowledges him. He will cause them to rule over many, and will divide the land for a price.

40 "At the time of the end the king of the south will contend with him; and the king of the north will come against him like a whirlwind, with chariots, with horsemen, and with many ships. He will enter into the countries, and will overflow and pass through.
41 He will enter also into the glorious land, and many countries will be overthrown; but these will be delivered out of his hand: Edom, Moab, and the chief of the children of Ammon.
42 He will also stretch out his hand on the countries. The land of Egypt won't escape.
43 But he will have power over the treasures of gold and of silver, and over all the precious things of Egypt. The Libyans and the Ethiopians will follow his steps.
44 But news out of the east and out of the north will trouble him; and he will go out with great fury to destroy and utterly to sweep away many.
45 He will plant the tents of his palace between the sea and the glorious holy mountain; yet he will come to his end, and no one will help him.

12

1 "At that time Michael will stand up, the great prince who stands for the children of your people; and there will be a time of trouble, such as never was since there was a nation even to that same time. At that time your people will be delivered, everyone who is found written in the book.
2 Many of those who sleep in the dust of the earth will awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt.
3 Those who are wise will shine as the brightness of the expanse. Those who turn many to righteousness will shine as the stars forever and ever.
4 But you, Daniel, shut up the words and seal the book, even to the time of the end. Many will run back and forth, and knowledge will be increased."

5 Then I, Daniel, looked, and behold, two others stood, one on the river bank on this side, and the other on the river bank on that side.
6 One said to the man clothed in linen, who was above the waters of the river, "How long will it be to the end of these wonders?"
7 I heard the man clothed in linen, who was above the waters of the river, when he held up his right hand and his left hand to heaven, and swore by him who lives forever that it will be for a time, times, and a half; and when they have finished breaking in pieces the power of the holy people, all these things will be finished.
8 I heard, but I didn't understand. Then I said, "My lord, what will be the outcome of these things?"

9 He said, "Go your way, Daniel; for the words are shut up and sealed until the time of the end.

10 Many will purify themselves, and
make themselves white, and be refined,
but the wicked will do wickedly; and none
of the wicked will understand, but those
who are wise will understand.
11 “From the time that the continual
burnt offering is taken away and the
abomination that makes desolate set up,
there will be one thousand two hundred
ninety days.
12 Blessed is he who waits, and comes to
the one thousand three hundred
thirty-five days.
13 “But go your way until the end; for
you will rest, and will stand in your
inheritance at the end of the days.”

The Book of Hosea

1 Yahweh's† word that came to Hosea
the son of Beeri, in the days of Uzziah,
Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of
Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam the
son of Joash, king of Israel.
2 When Yahweh spoke at first by Hosea,
Yahweh said to Hosea, "Go, take for
yourself a wife of prostitution and
children of unfaithfulness; for the land
commits great adultery, forsaking
Yahweh."
3 So he went and took Gomer the
daughter of Diblaim; and she conceived,
and bore him a son.
4 Yahweh said to him, "Call his name
Jezreel, for yet a little while, and I will
avenge the blood of Jezreel on the house
of Jehu, and will cause the kingdom of the
house of Israel to cease.
5 It will happen in that day that I will
break the bow of Israel in the valley of
Jezreel."
6 She conceived again, and bore a
daughter.
Then he said to him, "Call her name
Lo-Ruhamah,‡ for I will no longer have
mercy on the house of Israel, that I should
in any way pardon them.
7 But I will have mercy on the house of
Judah, and will save them by Yahweh
their God,§ and will not save them by
bow, sword, battle, horses, or horsemen."
8 Now when she had weaned
Lo-Ruhamah, she conceived, and bore a
son.
9 He said, "Call his name Lo-Ammi,† for
you are not my people, and I will not be
yours.
10 Yet the number of the children of
Israel will be as the sand of the sea, which
can't be measured or counted; and it will
come to pass that, in the place where it
was said to them, 'You are not my people,'
they will be called 'sons of the living God.'
11 The children of Judah and the
children of Israel will be gathered
together, and they will appoint
themselves one head, and will go up from
the land; for great will be the day of
Jezreel.

2

1 "Say to your brothers, 'My people!'†
and to your sisters, 'My loved one!'‡
2 Contend with your mother!
Contend, for she is not my wife,
neither am I her husband;
and let her put away her prostitution
from her face,
and her adulteries from between her
breasts;
3 lest I strip her naked,
and make her bare as in the day that
she was born,
and make her like a wilderness,
and set her like a dry land,
and kill her with thirst.
4 Indeed, on her children I will have no
mercy,
for they are children of
unfaithfulness.
5 For their mother has played the
prostitute.
She who conceived them has done
shamefully;
for she said, 'I will go after my lovers,
who give me my bread and my water,
my wool and my flax,
my oil and my drink.'
6 Therefore behold,§ I will hedge up your
way with thorns,
and I will build a wall against her,
that she can't find her way.
7 She will follow after her lovers,
but she won't overtake them;
and she will seek them,
but won't find them.
Then she will say, 'I will go and return to
my first husband,
for then it was better with me than
now.'

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:6** Lo-Ruhamah means "not loved". § **1:7** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). † **1:9** Lo-Ammi means "not my people". † **2:1** 'Ammi' in Hebrew ‡ **2:1** 'Ruhamah' in Hebrew § **2:6** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

8 For she didn't know that I gave her the
grain, the new wine, and the oil,
and multiplied to her silver and gold,
which they used for Baal.
9 Therefore I will take back my grain in its
time,
and my new wine in its season,
and will pluck away my wool and my
flax which should have covered her
nakedness.
10 Now I will uncover her lewdness in the
sight of her lovers,
and no one will deliver her out of my
hand.
11 I will also cause all her celebrations to
cease:
her feasts, her new moons, her
Sabbaths, and all her solemn
assemblies.
12 I will lay waste her vines and her fig
trees,
about which she has said, 'These are
my wages that my lovers have
given me,'
and I will make them a forest,
and the animals of the field shall eat
them.
13 I will visit on her the days of the Baals,
to which she burned incense
when she decked herself with her
earrings and her jewels,
and went after her lovers
and forgot me," says Yahweh.
14 "Therefore behold, I will allure her,
and bring her into the wilderness,
and speak tenderly to her.
15 I will give her vineyards from there,
and the valley of Achor for a door of
hope;
and she will respond there
as in the days of her youth,
and as in the day when she came up
out of the land of Egypt.
16 It will be in that day," says Yahweh,
"that you will call me 'my husband,'
and no longer call me 'my master.'
17 For I will take away the names of the
Baals out of her mouth,
and they will no longer be mentioned
by name.
18 In that day I will make a covenant for
them with the animals of the field,
and with the birds of the sky,
and with the creeping things of the
ground.
I will break the bow, the sword, and the
battle out of the land,
and will make them lie down safely.
19 I will betroth you to me forever.
Yes, I will betroth you to me in
righteousness, in justice, in loving
kindness, and in compassion.
20 I will even betroth you to me in
faithfulness;
and you shall know Yahweh.
21 It will happen in that day, that I will
respond," says Yahweh.
"I will respond to the heavens,
and they will respond to the earth;
22 and the earth will respond to the
grain, and the new wine, and the
oil;
and they will respond to Jezreel.
23 I will sow her to me in the earth;
and I will have mercy on her who had
not obtained mercy;
and I will tell those who were not my
people, 'You are my people;'
and they will say, 'You are My God!' "

3

1 Yahweh said to me, "Go again, love a
woman loved by another, and an
adulteress, even as Yahweh loves the
children of Israel, though they turn to
other gods, and love cakes of raisins."
2 So I bought her for myself for fifteen
pieces of silver and a homer† and a half of
barley.
3 I said to her, "You shall stay with me
many days. You shall not play the
prostitute, and you shall not be with any
other man. I will also be so toward you."
4 For the children of Israel shall live
many days without king, without prince,
without sacrifice, without sacred stone,
and without ephod or idols.
5 Afterward the children of Israel shall
return and seek Yahweh their God, and
David their king, and shall come with
trembling to Yahweh and to his blessings
in the last days.

† **3:2** 1 homer is about 220 liters or 6 bushels

4

1 Hear Yahweh's word, you children of Israel,
for Yahweh has a charge against the inhabitants of the land:
"Indeed there is no truth, nor goodness,
nor knowledge of God in the land.
2 There is cursing, lying, murder, stealing,
and committing adultery;
they break boundaries, and
bloodshed causes bloodshed.
3 Therefore the land will mourn,
and everyone who dwells in it will waste away,
with all living things in her,
even the animals of the field and the birds of the sky;
yes, the fish of the sea also die.

4 "Yet let no man bring a charge, neither let any man accuse;
for your people are like those who bring charges against a priest.
5 You will stumble in the day,
and the prophet will also stumble with you in the night;
and I will destroy your mother.
6 My people are destroyed for lack of knowledge.
Because you have rejected knowledge, I will also reject you,
that you may be no priest to me.
Because you have forgotten your God's law,
I will also forget your children.
7 As they were multiplied, so they sinned against me.
I will change their glory into shame.
8 They feed on the sin of my people,
and set their heart on their iniquity.
9 It will be like people, like priest;
and I will punish them for their ways,
and will repay them for their deeds.
10 They will eat, and not have enough.
They will play the prostitute, and will not increase;
because they have abandoned listening to Yahweh.
11 Prostitution, wine, and new wine take away understanding.
12 My people consult with their wooden idol,
and answer to a stick of wood.
Indeed the spirit of prostitution has led them astray,
and they have been unfaithful to their God.
13 They sacrifice on the tops of the mountains,
and burn incense on the hills, under oaks, poplars, and terebinths,
because its shade is good.
Therefore your daughters play the prostitute,
and your brides commit adultery.
14 I will not punish your daughters when they play the prostitute,
nor your brides when they commit adultery;
because the men consort with prostitutes,
and they sacrifice with the shrine prostitutes;
so the people without understanding will come to ruin.

15 "Though you, Israel, play the prostitute,
yet don't let Judah offend;
and don't come to Gilgal,
neither go up to Beth Aven,
nor swear, 'As Yahweh lives.'
16 For Israel has behaved extremely stubbornly, like a stubborn heifer.
Then how will Yahweh feed them like a lamb in a meadow?
17 Ephraim is joined to idols.
Leave him alone!
18 Their drink has become sour.
They play the prostitute continually.
Her rulers dearly love their shameful way.
19 The wind has wrapped her up in its wings;
and they shall be disappointed because of their sacrifices.

5

1 "Listen to this, you priests!
Listen, house of Israel,
and give ear, house of the king!
For the judgment is against you;
for you have been a snare at Mizpah,
and a net spread on Tabor.

2 The rebels are deep in slaughter,
but I discipline all of them.
3 I know Ephraim,
and Israel is not hidden from me;
for now, Ephraim, you have played the prostitute.
Israel is defiled.
4 Their deeds won't allow them to turn to their God,
for the spirit of prostitution is within them,
and they don't know Yahweh.
5 The pride of Israel testifies to his face.
Therefore Israel and Ephraim will stumble in their iniquity.
Judah also will stumble with them.
6 They will go with their flocks and with their herds to seek Yahweh,
but they won't find him.
He has withdrawn himself from them.
7 They are unfaithful to Yahweh;
for they have borne illegitimate children.
Now the new moon will devour them with their fields.

8 "Blow the cornet in Gibeah,
and the trumpet in Ramah!
Sound a battle cry at Beth Aven,
behind you, Benjamin!
9 Ephraim will become a desolation in the day of rebuke.
Among the tribes of Israel, I have made known that which will surely be.
10 The princes of Judah are like those who remove a landmark.
I will pour out my wrath on them like water.
11 Ephraim is oppressed,
he is crushed in judgment,
because he is intent in his pursuit of idols.
12 Therefore I am to Ephraim like a moth,
and to the house of Judah like rottenness.

13 "When Ephraim saw his sickness,
and Judah his wound,
then Ephraim went to Assyria,
and sent to King Jareb:
but he is not able to heal you,
neither will he cure you of your wound.
14 For I will be to Ephraim like a lion,
and like a young lion to the house of Judah.
I myself will tear in pieces and go away.
I will carry off, and there will be no one to deliver.
15 I will go and return to my place,
until they acknowledge their offense,
and seek my face.
In their affliction they will seek me earnestly."

6

1 "Come! Let's return to Yahweh;
for he has torn us to pieces,
and he will heal us;
he has injured us,
and he will bind up our wounds.
2 After two days he will revive us.
On the third day he will raise us up,
and we will live before him.
3 Let's acknowledge Yahweh.
Let's press on to know Yahweh.
As surely as the sun rises,
Yahweh will appear.
He will come to us like the rain,
like the spring rain that waters the earth."

4 "Ephraim, what shall I do to you?
Judah, what shall I do to you?
For your love is like a morning cloud,
and like the dew that disappears early.
5 Therefore I have cut them to pieces with the prophets;
I killed them with the words of my mouth.
Your judgments are like a flash of lightning.
6 For I desire mercy, and not sacrifice;
and the knowledge of God more than burnt offerings.
7 But they, like Adam, have broken the covenant.
They were unfaithful to me there.
8 Gilead is a city of those who work iniquity;
it is stained with blood.

9 As gangs of robbers wait to ambush a
man,
so the company of priests murder on
the path toward Shechem,
committing shameful crimes.
10 In the house of Israel I have seen a
horrible thing.
There is prostitution in Ephraim.
Israel is defiled.

11 “Also, Judah, there is a harvest
appointed for you,
when I restore the fortunes of my
people.

7

1 When I would heal Israel,
then the iniquity of Ephraim is
uncovered,
also the wickedness of Samaria;
for they commit falsehood,
and the thief enters in,
and the gang of robbers ravages
outside.
2 They don’t consider in their hearts that I
remember all their wickedness.
Now their own deeds have engulfed
them.
They are before my face.
3 They make the king glad with their
wickedness,
and the princes with their lies.
4 They are all adulterers.
They are burning like an oven that
the baker stops stirring,
from the kneading of the dough, until
it is leavened.
5 On the day of our king, the princes made
themselves sick with the heat of
wine.
He joined his hand with mockers.
6 For they have prepared their heart like
an oven,
while they lie in wait.
Their anger smolders all night.
In the morning it burns as a flaming
fire.
7 They are all hot as an oven,
and devour their judges.
All their kings have fallen.
There is no one among them who
calls to me.
8 Ephraim mixes himself among the
nations.
Ephraim is a pancake not turned over.
9 Strangers have devoured his strength,
and he doesn’t realize it.
Indeed, gray hairs are here and there on
him,
and he doesn’t realize it.
10 The pride of Israel testifies to his face;
yet they haven’t returned to Yahweh
their God,
nor sought him, for all this.

11 “Ephraim is like an easily deceived
dove, without understanding.
They call to Egypt.
They go to Assyria.
12 When they go, I will spread my net on
them.
I will bring them down like the birds
of the sky.
I will chastise them, as their
congregation has heard.
13 Woe to them!
For they have wandered from me.
Destruction to them!
For they have trespassed against me.
Though I would redeem them,
yet they have spoken lies against me.
14 They haven’t cried to me with their
heart,
but they howl on their beds.
They assemble themselves for grain and
new wine.
They turn away from me.
15 Though I have taught and strengthened
their arms,
yet they plot evil against me.
16 They return, but not to the Most High.
They are like a faulty bow.
Their princes will fall by the sword
for the rage of their tongue.
This will be their derision in the land
of Egypt.

8

1 “Put the trumpet to your lips!
Something like an eagle is over
Yahweh’s house,
because they have broken my
covenant
and rebelled against my law.

2 They cry to me, ‘My God, we, Israel,
acknowledge you!’
3 Israel has cast off that which is good.
The enemy will pursue him.
4 They have set up kings, but not by me.
They have made princes, and I didn’t
approve.
Of their silver and their gold they
have made themselves idols,
that they may be cut off.
5 Let Samaria throw out his calf idol!
My anger burns against them!
How long will it be until they are
capable of purity?
6 For this is even from Israel!
The workman made it, and it is no
God;
indeed, the calf of Samaria shall be
broken in pieces.
7 For they sow the wind,
and they will reap the whirlwind.
He has no standing grain.
The stalk will yield no head.
If it does yield, strangers will swallow
it up.
8 Israel is swallowed up.
Now they are among the nations like
a worthless thing.
9 For they have gone up to Assyria,
like a wild donkey wandering alone.
Ephraim has hired lovers for himself.
10 But although they sold themselves
among the nations,
I will now gather them;
and they begin to waste away because
of the oppression of the king of
mighty ones.
11 Because Ephraim has multiplied altars
for sinning,
they became for him altars for
sinning.
12 I wrote for him the many things of my
law,
but they were regarded as a strange
thing.
13 As for the sacrifices of my offerings,
they sacrifice meat and eat it,
but Yahweh doesn’t accept them.
Now he will remember their iniquity,
and punish their sins.
They will return to Egypt.
14 For Israel has forgotten his Maker and
built palaces;
and Judah has multiplied fortified
cities;
but I will send a fire on his cities,
and it will devour its fortresses.”

9

1 Don’t rejoice, Israel, to jubilation like
the nations;
for you were unfaithful to your God.
You love the wages of a prostitute at
every grain threshing floor.
2 The threshing floor and the wine press
won’t feed them,
and the new wine will fail her.
3 They won’t dwell in Yahweh’s land;
but Ephraim will return to Egypt,
and they will eat unclean food in
Assyria.
4 They won’t pour out wine offerings to
Yahweh,
neither will they be pleasing to him.
Their sacrifices will be to them like
the bread of mourners;
all who eat of it will be polluted;
for their bread will be for their
appetite.
It will not come into Yahweh’s house.
5 What will you do in the day of solemn
assembly,
and in the day of the feast of Yahweh?
6 For, behold, when they flee destruction,
Egypt will gather them up.
Memphis will bury them.
Nettles will possess their pleasant
things of silver.
Thorns will be in their tents.
7 The days of visitation have come.
The days of reckoning have come.
Israel will consider the prophet to be a
fool,
and the man who is inspired to be
insane,
because of the abundance of your
sins,
and because your hostility is great.
8 A prophet watches over Ephraim with
my God.
A fowler’s snare is on all of his paths,
and hostility in the house of his God.

9 They have deeply corrupted themselves,
as in the days of Gibeah.
He will remember their iniquity.
He will punish them for their sins.
10 I found Israel like grapes in the
wilderness.
I saw your fathers as the first ripe in
the fig tree at its first season;
but they came to Baal Peor, and
consecrated themselves to the
shameful thing,
and became abominable like that
which they loved.
11 As for Ephraim, their glory will fly away
like a bird.
There will be no birth, no one with
child, and no conception.
12 Though they bring up their children,
yet I will bereave them, so that not a
man shall be left.
Indeed, woe also to them when I
depart from them!
13 I have seen Ephraim, like Tyre, planted
in a pleasant place;
but Ephraim will bring out his
children to the murderer.
14 Give them—Yahweh what will you give?
Give them a miscarrying womb and
dry breasts.

15 "All their wickedness is in Gilgal;
for there I hated them.
Because of the wickedness of their
deeds, I will drive them out of my
house!
I will love them no more.
All their princes are rebels.
16 Ephraim is struck.
Their root has dried up.
They will bear no fruit.
Even though they give birth, yet I will
kill the beloved ones of their
womb."

17 My God will cast them away, because
they didn't listen to him;
and they will be wanderers among
the nations.

10

1 Israel is a luxuriant vine that produces
his fruit.
According to the abundance of his
fruit he has multiplied his altars.
As their land has prospered, they
have adorned their sacred stones.
2 Their heart is divided.
Now they will be found guilty.
He will demolish their altars.
He will destroy their sacred stones.
3 Surely now they will say, "We have no
king; for we don't fear Yahweh;
and the king, what can he do for us?"
4 They make promises, swearing falsely in
making covenants.
Therefore judgment springs up like
poisonous weeds in the furrows of
the field.
5 The inhabitants of Samaria will be in
terror for the calves of Beth Aven,
for its people will mourn over it,
along with its priests who rejoiced
over it,
for its glory, because it has departed
from it.
6 It also will be carried to Assyria for a
present to a great king.
Ephraim will receive shame,
and Israel will be ashamed of his own
counsel.
7 Samaria and her king float away
like a twig on the water.
8 The high places also of Aven, the sin of
Israel, will be destroyed.
The thorn and the thistle will come up
on their altars.
They will tell the mountains, "Cover
us!" and the hills, "Fall on us!"

9 "Israel, you have sinned from the days of
Gibeah.
There they remained.
The battle against the children of
iniquity doesn't overtake them in
Gibeah.
10 When it is my desire, I will chastise
them;
and the nations will be gathered
against them
when they are bound to their two
transgressions.
11 Ephraim is a trained heifer that loves to
thresh,
so I will put a yoke on her beautiful
neck.

I will set a rider on Ephraim.
Judah will plow.
Jacob will break his clods.
12 Sow to yourselves in righteousness,
reap according to kindness.
Break up your fallow ground,
for it is time to seek Yahweh,
until he comes and rains
righteousness on you.
13 You have plowed wickedness.
You have reaped iniquity.
You have eaten the fruit of lies,
for you trusted in your way, in the
multitude of your mighty men.
14 Therefore a battle roar will arise among
your people,
and all your fortresses will be
destroyed,
as Shalman destroyed Beth Arbel in
the day of battle.
The mother was dashed in pieces
with her children.
15 So Bethel will do to you because of your
great wickedness.
At daybreak the king of Israel will be
destroyed.

11

1 "When Israel was a child, then I loved
him,
and called my son out of Egypt.
2 They called to them, so they went from
them.
They sacrificed to the Baals,
and burned incense to engraved
images.
3 Yet I taught Ephraim to walk.
I took them by their arms,
but they didn't know that I healed
them.
4 I drew them with cords of a man, with
ties of love;
and I was to them like those who lift
up the yoke on their necks;
and I bent down to him and I fed him.

5 "They won't return into the land of
Egypt;
but the Assyrian will be their king,
because they refused to repent.
6 The sword will fall on their cities,
and will destroy the bars of their
gates,
and will put an end to their plans.
7 My people are determined to turn from
me.
Though they call to the Most High,
he certainly won't exalt them.

8 "How can I give you up, Ephraim?
How can I hand you over, Israel?
How can I make you like Admah?
How can I make you like Zeboiim?
My heart is turned within me,
my compassion is aroused.
9 I will not execute the fierceness of my
anger.
I will not return to destroy Ephraim,
for I am God, and not man—the Holy
One among you.
I will not come in wrath.
10 They will walk after Yahweh,
who will roar like a lion;
for he will roar, and the children will
come trembling from the west.
11 They will come trembling like a bird out
of Egypt,
and like a dove out of the land of
Assyria;
and I will settle them in their houses,"
says Yahweh.

12 Ephraim surrounds me with falsehood,
and the house of Israel with deceit.
Judah still strays from God,
and is unfaithful to the Holy One.

12

1 Ephraim feeds on wind,
and chases the east wind.
He continually multiplies lies and
desolation.
They make a covenant with Assyria,
and oil is carried into Egypt.
2 Yahweh also has a controversy with
Judah,
and will punish Jacob according to his
ways;
according to his deeds he will repay
him.
3 In the womb he took his brother by the
heel,
and in his manhood he contended
with God.

4 Indeed, he struggled with the angel, and prevailed;
he wept, and made supplication to him.
He found him at Bethel, and there he spoke with us—
5 even Yahweh, the God of Armies.
Yahweh is his name of renown!
6 Therefore turn to your God.
Keep kindness and justice,
and wait continually for your God.

7 A merchant has dishonest scales in his hand.
He loves to defraud.
8 Ephraim said, "Surely I have become rich.
I have found myself wealth.
In all my wealth they won't find in me any iniquity that is sin."

9 "But I am Yahweh your God from the land of Egypt.
I will yet again make you dwell in tents,
as in the days of the solemn feast.
10 I have also spoken to the prophets,
and I have multiplied visions;
and by the ministry of the prophets I have used parables.
11 If Gilead is wicked,
surely they are worthless.
In Gilgal they sacrifice bulls.
Indeed, their altars are like heaps in the furrows of the field.
12 Jacob fled into the country of Aram.
Israel served to get a wife.
For a wife he tended flocks and herds.
13 By a prophet Yahweh brought Israel up out of Egypt,
and by a prophet he was preserved.
14 Ephraim has bitterly provoked anger.
Therefore his blood will be left on him,
and his Lord† will repay his contempt.

13

1 When Ephraim spoke, there was trembling.
He exalted himself in Israel,
but when he became guilty through Baal, he died.

2 Now they sin more and more,
and have made themselves molten images of their silver,
even idols according to their own understanding,
all of them the work of the craftsmen.
They say of them, 'They offer human sacrifice and kiss the calves.'
3 Therefore they will be like the morning mist,
like the dew that passes away early,
like the chaff that is driven with the whirlwind out of the threshing floor,
and like the smoke out of the chimney.

4 "Yet I am Yahweh your God from the land of Egypt;
and you shall acknowledge no god but me,
and besides me there is no savior.
5 I knew you in the wilderness,
in the land of great drought.
6 According to their pasture, so were they filled;
they were filled, and their heart was exalted.
Therefore they have forgotten me.
7 Therefore I am like a lion to them.
Like a leopard, I will lurk by the path.
8 I will meet them like a bear that is bereaved of her cubs,
and will tear the covering of their heart.
There I will devour them like a lioness.
The wild animal will tear them.
9 You are destroyed, Israel, because you are against me,
against your helper.
10 Where is your king now, that he may save you in all your cities?
And your judges, of whom you said,
'Give me a king and princes'?
11 I have given you a king in my anger,
and have taken him away in my wrath.
12 The guilt of Ephraim is stored up.
His sin is stored up.
13 The sorrows of a travailing woman will come on him.

† **12:14** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai."

He is an unwise son,
for when it is time, he doesn't come to the opening of the womb.
14 I will ransom them from the power of Sheol.†
I will redeem them from death!
Death, where are your plagues?
Sheol, where is your destruction?

"Compassion will be hidden from my eyes.
15 Though he is fruitful among his brothers, an east wind will come,
the breath of Yahweh coming up from the wilderness;
and his spring will become dry,
and his fountain will be dried up.
He will plunder the storehouse of treasure.
16 Samaria will bear her guilt,
for she has rebelled against her God.
They will fall by the sword.
Their infants will be dashed in pieces,
and their pregnant women will be ripped open."

14

1 Israel, return to Yahweh your God;
for you have fallen because of your sin.
2 Take words with you, and return to Yahweh.
Tell him, "Forgive all our sins,
and accept that which is good;
so we offer bulls as we vowed of our lips.
3 Assyria can't save us.
We won't ride on horses;
neither will we say any more to the work of our hands, 'Our gods!'
for in you the fatherless finds mercy."

4 "I will heal their waywardness.
I will love them freely;
for my anger is turned away from them.
5 I will be like the dew to Israel.
He will blossom like the lily,
and send down his roots like Lebanon.
6 His branches will spread,
and his beauty will be like the olive tree,
and his fragrance like Lebanon.
7 Men will dwell in his shade.
They will revive like the grain,
and blossom like the vine.
Their fragrance will be like the wine of Lebanon.
8 Ephraim, what have I to do any more with idols?
I answer, and will take care of him.
I am like a green cypress tree;
from me your fruit is found."

9 Who is wise, that he may understand these things?
Who is prudent, that he may know them?
For the ways of Yahweh are right,
and the righteous walk in them,
but the rebellious stumble in them.

† **13:14** Sheol is the place of the dead.

The Book of Joel

1 Yahweh's† word that came to Joel, the
son of Pethuel.
2 Hear this, you elders,
and listen, all you inhabitants of the
land!
Has this ever happened in your days,
or in the days of your fathers?
3 Tell your children about it,
and have your children tell their
children,
and their children, another
generation.
4 What the swarming locust has left, the
great locust has eaten.
What the great locust has left, the
grasshopper has eaten.
What the grasshopper has left, the
caterpillar has eaten.
5 Wake up, you drunkards, and weep!
Wail, all you drinkers of wine,
because of the sweet wine,
for it is cut off from your mouth.
6 For a nation has come up on my land,
strong, and without number.
His teeth are the teeth of a lion,
and he has the fangs of a lioness.
7 He has laid my vine waste,
and stripped my fig tree.
He has stripped its bark, and thrown
it away.
Its branches are made white.
8 Mourn like a virgin dressed in sackcloth
for the husband of her youth!
9 The meal offering and the drink offering
are cut off from Yahweh's house.
The priests, Yahweh's ministers,
mourn.
10 The field is laid waste.
The land mourns, for the grain is
destroyed,
The new wine has dried up,
and the oil languishes.
11 Be confounded, you farmers!
Wail, you vineyard keepers,
for the wheat and for the barley;
for the harvest of the field has
perished.
12 The vine has dried up, and the fig tree
withered—
the pomegranate tree, the palm tree
also, and the apple tree,
even all of the trees of the field are
withered;
for joy has withered away from the
sons of men.
13 Put on sackcloth and mourn, you
priests!
Wail, you ministers of the altar.
Come, lie all night in sackcloth, you
ministers of my God,‡
for the meal offering and the drink
offering are withheld from your
God's house.
14 Sanctify a fast.
Call a solemn assembly.
Gather the elders and all the
inhabitants of the land to the house
of Yahweh, your God,
and cry to Yahweh.
15 Alas for the day!
For the day of Yahweh is at hand,
and it will come as destruction from
the Almighty.
16 Isn't the food cut off before our eyes,
joy and gladness from the house of
our God?
17 The seeds rot under their clods.
The granaries are laid desolate.
The barns are broken down, for the
grain has withered.
18 How the animals groan!
The herds of livestock are perplexed,
because they have no pasture.
Yes, the flocks of sheep are made
desolate.
19 Yahweh, I cry to you,
for the fire has devoured the pastures
of the wilderness,
and the flame has burned all the trees
of the field.
20 Yes, the animals of the field pant to you,
for the water brooks have dried up,
and the fire has devoured the
pastures of the wilderness.

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:13** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

2

1 Blow the trumpet in Zion,
and sound an alarm in my holy mountain!
Let all the inhabitants of the land tremble,
for the day of Yahweh comes,
for it is close at hand:
2 A day of darkness and gloominess,
a day of clouds and thick darkness.
As the dawn spreading on the mountains,
a great and strong people;
there has never been the like,
neither will there be any more after them,
even to the years of many generations.
3 A fire devours before them,
and behind them, a flame burns.
The land is as the garden of Eden before them,
and behind them, a desolate wilderness.
Yes, and no one has escaped them.
4 Their appearance is as the appearance of horses,
and they run as horsemen.
5 Like the noise of chariots on the tops of the mountains, they leap,
like the noise of a flame of fire that devours the stubble,
like a strong people set in battle array.
6 At their presence the peoples are in anguish.
All faces have grown pale.
7 They run like mighty men.
They climb the wall like warriors.
They each march in his line, and they don't swerve off course.
8 One doesn't jostle another.
They each march in their own path.
They burst through the defenses and don't break ranks.
9 They rush on the city.
They run on the wall.
They climb up into the houses.
They enter in at the windows like thieves.
10 The earth quakes before them.
The heavens tremble.
The sun and the moon are darkened,
and the stars withdraw their shining.
11 Yahweh thunders his voice before his army,
for his forces are very great;
for he is strong who obeys his command;
for the day of Yahweh is great and very awesome,
and who can endure it?
12 "Yet even now," says Yahweh, "turn to me with all your heart,
and with fasting, and with weeping, and with mourning."
13 Tear your heart and not your garments,
and turn to Yahweh, your God;
for he is gracious and merciful,
slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness,
and relents from sending calamity.
14 Who knows? He may turn and relent,
and leave a blessing behind him,
even a meal offering and a drink offering to Yahweh, your God.
15 Blow the trumpet in Zion!
Sanctify a fast.
Call a solemn assembly.
16 Gather the people.
Sanctify the assembly.
Assemble the elders.
Gather the children, and those who nurse from breasts.
Let the bridegroom go out of his room,
and the bride out of her chamber.
17 Let the priests, the ministers of Yahweh, weep between the porch and the altar,
and let them say, "Spare your people, Yahweh,
and don't give your heritage to reproach,
that the nations should rule over them.
Why should they say among the peoples, 'Where is their God?' "
18 Then Yahweh was jealous for his land,
and had pity on his people.
19 Yahweh answered his people,
"Behold,† I will send you grain, new wine, and oil,
and you will be satisfied with them;

† **2:19** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

and I will no more make you a
reproach among the nations.
20 But I will remove the northern army far
away from you,
and will drive it into a barren and
desolate land,
its front into the eastern sea,
and its back into the western sea;
and its stench will come up,
and its bad smell will rise."
Surely he has done great things.
21 Land, don't be afraid.
Be glad and rejoice, for Yahweh has
done great things.
22 Don't be afraid, you animals of the field;
for the pastures of the wilderness
spring up,
for the tree bears its fruit.
The fig tree and the vine yield their
strength.

23 "Be glad then, you children of Zion,
and rejoice in Yahweh, your God;
for he gives you the early rain in just
measure,
and he causes the rain to come down
for you,
the early rain and the latter rain, as
before.
24 The threshing floors will be full of
wheat,
and the vats will overflow with new
wine and oil.
25 I will restore to you the years that the
swarming locust has eaten,
the great locust, the grasshopper, and
the caterpillar,
my great army, which I sent among
you.
26 You will have plenty to eat and be
satisfied,
and will praise the name of Yahweh,
your God,
who has dealt wondrously with you;
and my people will never again be
disappointed.
27 You will know that I am among Israel,
and that I am Yahweh, your God, and
there is no one else;
and my people will never again be
disappointed.
28 "It will happen afterward, that I will
pour out my Spirit on all flesh;
and your sons and your daughters
will prophesy.
Your old men will dream dreams.
Your young men will see visions.
29 And also on the servants and on the
handmaids in those days,
I will pour out my Spirit.
30 I will show wonders in the heavens and
in the earth:
blood, fire, and pillars of smoke.
31 The sun will be turned into darkness,
and the moon into blood,
before the great and terrible day of
Yahweh comes.
32 It will happen that whoever will call on
Yahweh's name shall be saved;
for in Mount Zion and in Jerusalem
there will be those who escape,
as Yahweh has said,
and among the remnant, those whom
Yahweh calls.

3

1 "For, behold, in those days,
and in that time,
when I restore the fortunes of Judah
and Jerusalem,
2 I will gather all nations,
and will bring them down into the
valley of Jehoshaphat;
and I will execute judgment on them
there for my people,
and for my heritage, Israel, whom
they have scattered among the
nations.
They have divided my land,
3 and have cast lots for my people,
and have given a boy for a prostitute,
and sold a girl for wine, that they may
drink.

4 "Yes, and what are you to me, Tyre and
Sidon,
and all the regions of Philistia?
Will you repay me?
And if you repay me,
I will swiftly and speedily return your
repayment on your own head.
5 Because you have taken my silver and
my gold,

and have carried my finest treasures
into your temples,
6 and have sold the children of Judah
and the children of Jerusalem to the
sons of the Greeks,
that you may remove them far from
their border.
7 Behold, I will stir them up out of the
place where you have sold them,
and will return your repayment on
your own head;
8 and I will sell your sons and your
daughters into the hands of the
children of Judah,
and they will sell them to the men of
Sheba,
to a faraway nation,
for Yahweh has spoken it."

9 Proclaim this among the nations:
"Prepare for war!
Stir up the mighty men.
Let all the warriors draw near.
Let them come up.
10 Beat your plowshares into swords,
and your pruning hooks into spears.
Let the weak say, 'I am strong.'
11 Hurry and come, all you surrounding
nations,
and gather yourselves together."
Cause your mighty ones to come down
there, Yahweh.
12 "Let the nations arouse themselves,
and come up to the valley of
Jehoshaphat;
for there I will sit to judge all the
surrounding nations.
13 Put in the sickle;
for the harvest is ripe.
Come, tread, for the wine press is full,
the vats overflow, for their
wickedness is great."
14 Multitudes, multitudes in the valley of
decision!
For the day of Yahweh is near in the
valley of decision.
15 The sun and the moon are darkened,
and the stars withdraw their shining.
16 Yahweh will roar from Zion,
and thunder from Jerusalem;
and the heavens and the earth will
shake;
but Yahweh will be a refuge to his
people,
and a stronghold to the children of
Israel.
17 "So you will know that I am Yahweh,
your God,
dwelling in Zion, my holy mountain.
Then Jerusalem will be holy,
and no strangers will pass through
her any more.
18 It will happen in that day,
that the mountains will drop down
sweet wine,
the hills will flow with milk,
all the brooks of Judah will flow with
waters;
and a fountain will flow out from
Yahweh's house,
and will water the valley of Shittim.
19 Egypt will be a desolation
and Edom will be a desolate
wilderness,
for the violence done to the children
of Judah,
because they have shed innocent
blood in their land.
20 But Judah will be inhabited forever,
and Jerusalem from generation to
generation.
21 I will cleanse their blood
that I have not cleansed,
for Yahweh dwells in Zion."

The Book of Amos

1 The words of Amos, who was among
the herdsmen of Tekoa, which he saw
concerning Israel in the days of Uzziah
king of Judah and in the days of Jeroboam
the son of Joash, king of Israel, two years
before the earthquake.
2 He said:
"Yahweh† will roar from Zion,
and utter his voice from Jerusalem;
and the pastures of the shepherds will
mourn,
and the top of Carmel will wither."
3 Yahweh says:
"For three transgressions of Damascus,
yes, for four,
I will not turn away its punishment,
because they have threshed Gilead
with threshing instruments of iron;
4 but I will send a fire into the house of
Hazael,
and it will devour the palaces of Ben
Hadad.
5 I will break the bar of Damascus,
and cut off the inhabitant from the
valley of Aven,
and him who holds the scepter from
the house of Eden;
and the people of Syria shall go into
captivity to Kir,"
says Yahweh.
6 Yahweh says:
"For three transgressions of Gaza, yes, for
four,
I will not turn away its punishment,
because they carried away captive
the whole community,
to deliver them up to Edom;
7 but I will send a fire on the wall of Gaza,
and it will devour its palaces.
8 I will cut off the inhabitant from Ashdod,
and him who holds the scepter from
Ashkelon;
and I will turn my hand against Ekron;
and the remnant of the Philistines
will perish,"
says the Lord‡ Yahweh.
9 Yahweh says:
"For three transgressions of Tyre, yes, for
four,
I will not turn away its punishment;
because they delivered up the whole
community to Edom,
and didn't remember the brotherly
covenant;
10 but I will send a fire on the wall of Tyre,
and it will devour its palaces."
11 Yahweh says:
"For three transgressions of Edom, yes,
for four,
I will not turn away its punishment,
because he pursued his brother with
the sword
and cast off all pity,
and his anger raged continually,
and he kept his wrath forever;
12 but I will send a fire on Teman,
and it will devour the palaces of
Bozrah."
13 Yahweh says:
"For three transgressions of the children
of Ammon, yes, for four,
I will not turn away its punishment,
because they have ripped open the
pregnant women of Gilead,
that they may enlarge their border.
14 But I will kindle a fire in the wall of
Rabbah,
and it will devour its palaces,
with shouting in the day of battle,
with a storm in the day of the
whirlwind;
15 and their king will go into captivity,
he and his princes together,"
says Yahweh.

2

1 Yahweh says:
"For three transgressions of Moab, yes, for
four,
I will not turn away its punishment,
because he burned the bones of the
king of Edom into lime;
2 but I will send a fire on Moab,
and it will devour the palaces of
Kerioth;

† **1:2** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:8** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai."

and Moab will die with tumult, with
shouting, and with the sound of the
trumpet;
3 and I will cut off the judge from among
them,
and will kill all its princes with him,"
says Yahweh.
4 Yahweh says:
"For three transgressions of Judah, yes,
for four,
I will not turn away its punishment,
because they have rejected Yahweh's
law,
and have not kept his statutes,
and their lies have led them astray,
after which their fathers walked;
5 but I will send a fire on Judah,
and it will devour the palaces of
Jerusalem."
6 Yahweh says:
"For three transgressions of Israel, yes, for
four,
I will not turn away its punishment,
because they have sold the righteous
for silver,
and the needy for a pair of sandals;
7 They trample the heads of the poor
into the dust of the earth
and deny justice to the oppressed.
A man and his father use the same
maiden, to profane my holy name.
8 They lay themselves down beside
every altar on clothes taken in
pledge.
In the house of their God† they drink
the wine of those who have been
fined.
9 Yet I destroyed the Amorite before them,
whose height was like the height of
the cedars,
and he was strong as the oaks;
yet I destroyed his fruit from above,
and his roots from beneath.
10 Also I brought you up out of the land of
Egypt
and led you forty years in the
wilderness,
to possess the land of the Amorite.
11 I raised up some of your sons for
prophets,
and some of your young men for
Nazirites.
Isn't this true,
you children of Israel?" says Yahweh.
12 "But you gave the Nazirites wine to
drink,
and commanded the prophets,
saying, 'Don't prophesy!'
13 Behold,‡ I will crush you in your place,
as a cart crushes that is full of grain.
14 Flight will perish from the swift.
The strong won't strengthen his force.
The mighty won't deliver himself.
15 He who handles the bow won't stand.
He who is swift of foot won't escape.
He who rides the horse won't deliver
himself.
16 He who is courageous among the
mighty
will flee away naked on that day,"
says Yahweh.

3

1 Hear this word that Yahweh has
spoken against you, children of Israel,
against the whole family which I brought
up out of the land of Egypt, saying:
2 "I have only chosen you of all the
families of the earth.
Therefore I will punish you for all of
your sins."
3 Do two walk together,
unless they have agreed?
4 Will a lion roar in the thicket,
when he has no prey?
Does a young lion cry out of his den,
if he has caught nothing?
5 Can a bird fall in a trap on the earth,
where no snare is set for him?
Does a snare spring up from the ground,
when there is nothing to catch?
6 Does the trumpet alarm sound in a city,
without the people being afraid?
Does evil happen to a city,
and Yahweh hasn't done it?
7 Surely the Lord Yahweh will do nothing,
unless he reveals his secret to his
servants the prophets.
8 The lion has roared.
Who will not fear?

† **2:8** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).
‡ **2:13** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

The Lord Yahweh has spoken.
Who can but prophesy?
9 Proclaim in the palaces at Ashdod,
and in the palaces in the land of Egypt,
and say, “Assemble yourselves on the mountains of Samaria,
and see what unrest is in her,
and what oppression is among them.”
10 “Indeed they don’t know to do right,” says Yahweh,
“Who hoard plunder and loot in their palaces.”
11 Therefore the Lord Yahweh says:
“An adversary will overrun the land;
and he will pull down your strongholds,
and your fortresses will be plundered.”
12 Yahweh says:
“As the shepherd rescues out of the mouth of the lion two legs,
or a piece of an ear,
so shall the children of Israel be rescued who sit in Samaria on the corner of a couch,
and on the silken cushions of a bed.”
13 “Listen, and testify against the house of Jacob,” says the Lord Yahweh, the God of Armies.
14 “For in the day that I visit the transgressions of Israel on him,
I will also visit the altars of Bethel;
and the horns of the altar will be cut off,
and fall to the ground.
15 I will strike the winter house with the summer house;
and the houses of ivory will perish,
and the great houses will have an end,”
says Yahweh.

4

1 Listen to this word, you cows of Bashan, who are on the mountain of Samaria, who oppress the poor, who crush the needy, who tell their husbands, “Bring us drinks!”
2 The Lord Yahweh has sworn by his holiness,
“Behold, the days shall come on you that they will take you away with hooks,
and the last of you with fish hooks.
3 You will go out at the breaks in the wall,
everyone straight before her;
and you will cast yourselves into Harmon,” says Yahweh.
4 “Go to Bethel, and sin;
to Gilgal, and sin more.
Bring your sacrifices every morning,
your tithes every three days,
5 offer a sacrifice of thanksgiving of that which is leavened,
and proclaim free will offerings and brag about them;
for this pleases you, you children of Israel,” says the Lord Yahweh.
6 “I also have given you cleanness of teeth in all your cities,
and lack of bread in every town;
yet you haven’t returned to me,” says Yahweh.
7 “I also have withheld the rain from you,
when there were yet three months to the harvest;
and I caused it to rain on one city,
and caused it not to rain on another city.
One field was rained on,
and the field where it didn’t rain withered.
8 So two or three cities staggered to one city to drink water,
and were not satisfied;
yet you haven’t returned to me,” says Yahweh.
9 “I struck you with blight and mildew many times in your gardens and your vineyards,
and the swarming locusts have devoured your fig trees and your olive trees;
yet you haven’t returned to me,” says Yahweh.
10 “I sent plagues among you like I did Egypt.
I have slain your young men with the sword,
and have carried away your horses.
I filled your nostrils with the stench of your camp,

yet you haven't returned to me," says
Yahweh.
11 "I have overthrown some of you,
as when God overthrew Sodom and
Gomorrah,
and you were like a burning stick
plucked out of the fire;
yet you haven't returned to me," says
Yahweh.
12 "Therefore I will do this to you, Israel;
because I will do this to you,
prepare to meet your God, Israel.
13 For, behold, he who forms the
mountains, creates the wind,
declares to man what is his thought,
who makes the morning darkness,
and treads on the high places of the
earth:
Yahweh, the God of Armies, is his
name."

5

1 Listen to this word which I take up for
a lamentation over you, O house of Israel:
2 "The virgin of Israel has fallen;
She shall rise no more.
She is cast down on her land;
there is no one to raise her up."
3 For the Lord Yahweh says:
"The city that went out a thousand shall
have a hundred left,
and that which went out one hundred
shall have ten left to the house of
Israel."
4 For Yahweh says to the house of Israel:
"Seek me, and you will live;
5 but don't seek Bethel,
nor enter into Gilgal,
and don't pass to Beersheba;
for Gilgal shall surely go into captivity,
and Bethel shall come to nothing.
6 Seek Yahweh, and you will live,
lest he break out like fire in the house
of Joseph,
and it devour, and there be no one to
quench it in Bethel.
7 You who turn justice to wormwood,
and cast down righteousness to the
earth!
8 Seek him who made the Pleiades and
Orion,
and turns the shadow of death into
the morning,
and makes the day dark with night;
who calls for the waters of the sea,
and pours them out on the surface of
the earth, Yahweh is his name,
9 who brings sudden destruction on the
strong,
so that destruction comes on the
fortress.
10 They hate him who reproves in the gate,
and they abhor him who speaks
blamelessly.
11 Therefore, because you trample on the
poor and take taxes from him of
wheat,
you have built houses of cut stone,
but you will not dwell in them.
You have planted pleasant vineyards,
but you shall not drink their wine.
12 For I know how many are your offenses,
and how great are your sins—
you who afflict the just,
who take a bribe,
and who turn away the needy in the
courts.
13 Therefore a prudent person keeps silent
in such a time,
for it is an evil time.
14 Seek good, and not evil,
that you may live;
and so Yahweh, the God of Armies,
will be with you,
as you say.
15 Hate evil, love good,
and establish justice in the courts.
It may be that Yahweh, the God of
Armies, will be gracious to the
remnant of Joseph."
16 Therefore Yahweh, the God of
Armies, the Lord, says:
"Wailing will be in all the wide ways.
They will say in all the streets, 'Alas!
Alas!'
They will call the farmer to mourning,
and those who are skillful in
lamentation to wailing.
17 In all vineyards there will be wailing,
for I will pass through the middle of
you," says Yahweh.
18 "Woe to you who desire the day of
Yahweh!
Why do you long for the day of
Yahweh?
It is darkness,
and not light.

19 As if a man fled from a lion,
and a bear met him;
or he went into the house and leaned his hand on the wall,
and a snake bit him.
20 Won't the day of Yahweh be darkness, and not light?
Even very dark, and no brightness in it?
21 I hate, I despise your feasts,
and I can't stand your solemn assemblies.
22 Yes, though you offer me your burnt offerings and meal offerings,
I will not accept them;
neither will I regard the peace offerings of your fat animals.
23 Take away from me the noise of your songs!
I will not listen to the music of your harps.
24 But let justice roll on like rivers,
and righteousness like a mighty stream.
25 "Did you bring to me sacrifices and offerings in the wilderness forty years, house of Israel?
26 You also carried the tent of your king and the shrine of your images, the star of your god, which you made for yourselves.
27 Therefore I will cause you to go into captivity beyond Damascus," says Yahweh, whose name is the God of Armies.

6

1 Woe to those who are at ease in Zion,
and to those who are secure on the mountain of Samaria,
the notable men of the chief of the nations,
to whom the house of Israel come!
2 Go to Calneh, and see.
From there go to Hamath the great.
Then go down to Gath of the Philistines.
Are they better than these kingdoms?
Is their border greater than your border?
3 Alas for you who put far away the evil day,
and cause the seat of violence to come near,
4 who lie on beds of ivory,
and stretch themselves on their couches,
and eat the lambs out of the flock,
and the calves out of the middle of the stall,
5 who strum on the strings of a harp,
who invent for themselves instruments of music, like David;
6 who drink wine in bowls,
and anoint themselves with the best oils,
but they are not grieved for the affliction of Joseph.
7 Therefore they will now go captive with the first who go captive.
The feasting and lounging will end.
8 "The Lord Yahweh has sworn by himself," says Yahweh, the God of Armies:
"I abhor the pride of Jacob,
and detest his fortresses.
Therefore I will deliver up the city with all that is in it.
9 It will happen that if ten men remain in one house,
they will die.
10 "When a man's relative carries him, even he who burns him, to bring bodies out of the house, and asks him who is in the innermost parts of the house, 'Is there yet any with you?' And he says, 'No;' then he will say, 'Hush! Indeed we must not mention Yahweh's name.'

11 "For, behold, Yahweh commands, and the great house will be smashed to pieces,
and the little house into bits.
12 Do horses run on the rocky crags?
Does one plow there with oxen?
But you have turned justice into poison,
and the fruit of righteousness into bitterness,
13 you who rejoice in a thing of nothing, who say,
'Haven't we taken for ourselves horns by our own strength?'
14 For, behold, I will raise up against you a nation, house of Israel,"
says Yahweh, the God of Armies;
"and they will afflict you from the entrance of Hamath to the brook of the Arabah."

7

1 Thus the Lord Yahweh showed me:
behold, he formed locusts in the
beginning of the shooting up of the latter
growth; and behold, it was the latter
growth after the king's harvest.
2 When they finished eating the grass of
the land, then I said, "Lord Yahweh,
forgive, I beg you! How could Jacob
stand? For he is small."
3 Yahweh relented concerning this. "It
shall not be," says Yahweh.
4 Thus the Lord Yahweh showed me:
behold, the Lord Yahweh called for
judgment by fire; and it dried up the great
deep, and would have devoured the land.
5 Then I said, "Lord Yahweh, stop, I beg
you! How could Jacob stand? For he is
small."
6 Yahweh relented concerning this.
"This also shall not be," says the Lord
Yahweh.
7 Thus he showed me: behold, the Lord
stood beside a wall made by a plumb line,
with a plumb line in his hand.
8 Yahweh said to me, "Amos, what do
you see?"
I said, "A plumb line."
Then the Lord said, "Behold, I will set a
plumb line in the middle of my people
Israel. I will not again pass by them any
more.
9 The high places of Isaac will be
desolate, the sanctuaries of Israel will be
laid waste; and I will rise against the
house of Jeroboam with the sword."
10 Then Amaziah the priest of Bethel
sent to Jeroboam king of Israel, saying,
"Amos has conspired against you in the
middle of the house of Israel. The land is
not able to bear all his words.
11 For Amos says, 'Jeroboam will die by
the sword, and Israel shall surely be led
away captive out of his land.' "
12 Amaziah also said to Amos, "You seer,
go, flee away into the land of Judah, and
there eat bread, and prophesy there,
13 but don't prophesy again any more at
Bethel; for it is the king's sanctuary, and it
is a royal house!"
14 Then Amos answered Amaziah, "I
was no prophet, neither was I a prophet's
son, but I was a herdsman, and a farmer
of sycamore figs;
15 and Yahweh took me from following
the flock, and Yahweh said to me, 'Go,
prophesy to my people Israel.'
16 Now therefore listen to Yahweh's
word: 'You say, Don't prophesy against
Israel, and don't preach against the house
of Isaac.'
17 Therefore Yahweh says: 'Your wife
shall be a prostitute in the city, and your
sons and your daughters shall fall by the
sword, and your land shall be divided by
line; and you yourself shall die in a land
that is unclean, and Israel shall surely be
led away captive out of his land.' "

8

1 Thus the Lord Yahweh showed me:
behold, a basket of summer fruit.
2 He said, "Amos, what do you see?"
I said, "A basket of summer fruit."
Then Yahweh said to me,
"The end has come on my people Israel.
I will not again pass by them any
more.
3 The songs of the temple will be wailing
in that day," says the Lord Yahweh.
"The dead bodies will be many. In
every place they will throw them
out with silence.
4 Hear this, you who desire to swallow up
the needy,
and cause the poor of the land to fail,
5 saying, 'When will the new moon be
gone, that we may sell grain?
And the Sabbath, that we may market
wheat,
making the ephah† small, and the
shekel‡ large,
and dealing falsely with balances of
deceit;
6 that we may buy the poor for silver,
and the needy for a pair of sandals,
and sell the sweepings with the
wheat?' "
7 Yahweh has sworn by the pride of Jacob,

† **8:5** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

‡ **8:5** a normal shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces.

"Surely I will never forget any of their
works.
8 Won't the land tremble for this,
and everyone mourn who dwells in
it?
Yes, it will rise up wholly like the River;
and it will be stirred up and sink
again, like the River of Egypt.
9 It will happen in that day," says the Lord
Yahweh,
"that I will cause the sun to go down
at noon,
and I will darken the earth in the
clear day.
10 I will turn your feasts into mourning,
and all your songs into lamentation;
and I will make you wear sackcloth on all
your bodies,
and baldness on every head.
I will make it like the mourning for an
only son,
and its end like a bitter day.
11 Behold, the days come," says the Lord
Yahweh,
"that I will send a famine in the land,
not a famine of bread,
nor a thirst for water,
but of hearing Yahweh's words.
12 They will wander from sea to sea,
and from the north even to the east;
they will run back and forth to seek
Yahweh's word,
and will not find it.
13 In that day the beautiful virgins
and the young men will faint for
thirst.
14 Those who swear by the sin of Samaria,
and say, 'As your god, Dan, lives,'
and, 'As the way of Beersheba lives,'
they will fall, and never rise up
again."

9

1 I saw the Lord standing beside the
altar, and he said, "Strike the tops of the
pillars, that the thresholds may shake.
Break them in pieces on the head of all of
them. I will kill the last of them with the
sword. Not one of them will flee away.
Not one of them will escape.
2 Though they dig into Sheol,† there my
hand will take them; and though they
climb up to heaven, there I will bring
them down.
3 Though they hide themselves in the
top of Carmel, I will search and take them
out from there; and though they be
hidden from my sight in the bottom of the
sea, there I will command the serpent,
and it will bite them.
4 Though they go into captivity before
their enemies, there I will command the
sword, and it will kill them. I will set my
eyes on them for evil, and not for good.
5 For the Lord, Yahweh of Armies, is he
who touches the land and it melts, and all
who dwell in it will mourn; and it will rise
up wholly like the River, and will sink
again, like the River of Egypt.
6 It is he who builds his rooms in the
heavens, and has founded his vault on the
earth; he who calls for the waters of the
sea, and pours them out on the surface of
the earth—Yahweh is his name.
7 Are you not like the children of the
Ethiopians to me, children of Israel?" says
Yahweh. "Haven't I brought up Israel out
of the land of Egypt, and the Philistines
from Caphtor, and the Syrians from Kir?
8 Behold, the eyes of the Lord Yahweh
are on the sinful kingdom, and I will
destroy it from off the surface of the earth,
except that I will not utterly destroy the
house of Jacob," says Yahweh.
9 "For behold, I will command, and I will
sift the house of Israel among all the
nations as grain is sifted in a sieve, yet not
the least kernel will fall on the earth.
10 All the sinners of my people will die
by the sword, who say, 'Evil won't
overtake nor meet us.'
11 In that day I will raise up the tent of
David who is fallen and close up its
breaches, and I will raise up its ruins, and
I will build it as in the days of old,
12 that they may possess the remnant of
Edom and all the nations who are called
by my name," says Yahweh who does this.
13 "Behold, the days come," says Yahweh,
"that the plowman shall overtake the
reaper,

† **9:2** Sheol is the place of the dead.

and the one treading grapes him who
sows seed;
and sweet wine will drip from the
mountains,
and flow from the hills.
14 I will bring my people Israel back from
captivity,
and they will rebuild the ruined
cities, and inhabit them;
and they will plant vineyards, and
drink wine from them.
They shall also make gardens,
and eat their fruit.
15 I will plant them on their land,
and they will no more be plucked up
out of their land which I have given
them,”
says Yahweh your God.

The Book of Obadiah

1 The vision of Obadiah. This is what the Lord† Yahweh‡ says about Edom. We have heard news from Yahweh, and an ambassador is sent among the nations, saying, “Arise, and let’s rise up against her in battle.
2 Behold,§ I have made you small among the nations. You are greatly despised.
3 The pride of your heart has deceived you, you who dwell in the clefts of the rock, whose habitation is high, who says in his heart, ‘Who will bring me down to the ground?’
4 Though you mount on high as the eagle, and though your nest is set among the stars, I will bring you down from there,” says Yahweh.
5 “If thieves came to you, if robbers by night—oh, what disaster awaits you—wouldn’t they only steal until they had enough? If grape pickers came to you, wouldn’t they leave some gleaning grapes?
6 How Esau will be ransacked! How his hidden treasures are sought out!
7 All the men of your alliance have brought you on your way, even to the border. The men who were at peace with you have deceived you, and prevailed against you. Friends who eat your bread lay a snare under you. There is no understanding in him.”
8 “Won’t I in that day”, says Yahweh, “destroy the wise men out of Edom, and understanding out of the mountain of Esau?
9 Your mighty men, Teman, will be dismayed, to the end that everyone may be cut off from the mountain of Esau by slaughter.
10 For the violence done to your brother Jacob, shame will cover you, and you will be cut off forever.
11 In the day that you stood on the other side, in the day that strangers carried away his substance and foreigners entered into his gates and cast lots for Jerusalem, even you were like one of them.
12 But don’t look down on your brother in the day of his disaster, and don’t rejoice over the children of Judah in the day of their destruction. Don’t speak proudly in the day of distress.
13 Don’t enter into the gate of my people in the day of their calamity. Don’t look down on their affliction in the day of their calamity, neither seize their wealth on the day of their calamity.
14 Don’t stand in the crossroads to cut off those of his who escape. Don’t deliver up those of his who remain in the day of distress.
15 For the day of Yahweh is near all the nations! As you have done, it will be done to you. Your deeds will return upon your own head.
16 For as you have drunk on my holy mountain, so all the nations will drink continually. Yes, they will drink, swallow down, and will be as though they had not been.
17 But in Mount Zion, there will be those who escape, and it will be holy. The house of Jacob will possess their possessions.
18 The house of Jacob will be a fire, the house of Joseph a flame, and the house of Esau for stubble. They will burn among them and devour them. There will not be any remaining to the house of Esau.” Indeed, Yahweh has spoken.

19 Those of the South will possess the mountain of Esau, and those of the lowland, the Philistines. They will possess the field of Ephraim, and the field of Samaria. Benjamin will possess Gilead.
20 The captives of this army of the children of Israel, who are among the Canaanites, will possess even to Zarephath; and the captives of Jerusalem, who are in Sepharad, will possess the

† **1:1** The word translated “Lord” is “Adonai.” ‡ **1:1** “Yahweh” is God’s proper Name, sometimes rendered “LORD” (all caps) in other translations. § **1:2** “Behold”, from “הִנֵּה”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

cities of the Negev.
21 Saviors will go up on Mount Zion to
judge the mountains of Esau, and the
kingdom will be Yahweh's.

The Book of Jonah

1 Now Yahweh's† word came to Jonah
the son of Amittai, saying,
2 "Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city,
and preach against it, for their
wickedness has come up before me."
3 But Jonah rose up to flee to Tarshish
from the presence of Yahweh. He went
down to Joppa, and found a ship going to
Tarshish; so he paid its fare, and went
down into it, to go with them to Tarshish
from the presence of Yahweh.
4 But Yahweh sent out a great wind on
the sea, and there was a mighty storm on
the sea, so that the ship was likely to break
up.
5 Then the mariners were afraid, and
every man cried to his god. They threw
the cargo that was in the ship into the sea
to lighten the ship. But Jonah had gone
down into the innermost parts of the ship
and he was laying down, and was fast
asleep.
6 So the ship master came to him, and
said to him, "What do you mean, sleeper?
Arise, call on your God!‡ Maybe your God§
will notice us, so that we won't perish."
7 They all said to each other, "Come!
Let's cast lots, that we may know who is
responsible for this evil that is on us." So
they cast lots, and the lot fell on Jonah.
8 Then they asked him, "Tell us, please,
for whose cause this evil is on us. What is
your occupation? Where do you come
from? What is your country? Of what
people are you?"
9 He said to them, "I am a Hebrew, and I
fear Yahweh, the God† of heaven, who has
made the sea and the dry land."
10 Then the men were exceedingly
afraid, and said to him, "What have you
done?" For the men knew that he was
fleeing from the presence of Yahweh,
because he had told them.
11 Then they said to him, "What shall we
do to you, that the sea may be calm to us?"
For the sea grew more and more stormy.
12 He said to them, "Take me up, and
throw me into the sea. Then the sea will
be calm for you; for I know that because
of me this great storm is on you."
13 Nevertheless the men rowed hard to
get them back to the land; but they could
not, for the sea grew more and more
stormy against them.
14 Therefore they cried to Yahweh, and
said, "We beg you, Yahweh, we beg you,
don't let us die for this man's life, and
don't lay on us innocent blood; for you,
Yahweh, have done as it pleased you."
15 So they took up Jonah and threw him
into the sea; and the sea ceased its raging.
16 Then the men feared Yahweh
exceedingly; and they offered a sacrifice
to Yahweh and made vows.
17 Yahweh prepared a huge fish to
swallow up Jonah, and Jonah was in the
belly of the fish three days and three
nights.

2

1 Then Jonah prayed to Yahweh, his
God, out of the fish's belly.
2 He said,
"I called because of my affliction to
Yahweh.
He answered me.
Out of the belly of Sheol† I cried.
You heard my voice.
3 For you threw me into the depths,
in the heart of the seas.
The flood was all around me.
All your waves and your billows
passed over me.
4 I said, 'I have been banished from your
sight;
yet I will look again toward your holy
temple.'
5 The waters surrounded me,
even to the soul.
The deep was around me.
The weeds were wrapped around my
head.

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:6** or, gods
§ **1:6** or, gods † **1:9** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). † **2:2** Sheol is the place of the dead.

6 I went down to the bottoms of the
mountains.
The earth barred me in forever;
yet you have brought my life up from
the pit, Yahweh my God.

7 "When my soul fainted within me, I
remembered Yahweh.
My prayer came in to you, into your
holy temple.
8 Those who regard vain idols forsake
their own mercy.
9 But I will sacrifice to you with the
voice of thanksgiving.
I will pay that which I have vowed.
Salvation belongs to Yahweh."
10 Then Yahweh spoke to the fish, and it vomited out Jonah on the dry land.

3

1 Yahweh's word came to Jonah the second time, saying,
2 "Arise, go to Nineveh, that great city, and preach to it the message that I give you."
3 So Jonah arose, and went to Nineveh, according to Yahweh's word. Now Nineveh was an exceedingly great city, three days' journey across.
4 Jonah began to enter into the city a day's journey, and he cried out, and said, "In forty days, Nineveh will be overthrown!"
5 The people of Nineveh believed God; and they proclaimed a fast and put on sackcloth, from their greatest even to their least.
6 The news reached the king of Nineveh, and he arose from his throne, took off his royal robe, covered himself with sackcloth, and sat in ashes.
7 He made a proclamation and published through Nineveh by the decree of the king and his nobles, saying, "Let neither man nor animal, herd nor flock, taste anything; let them not feed, nor drink water;
8 but let them be covered with sackcloth, both man and animal, and let them cry mightily to God. Yes, let them turn everyone from his evil way and from the violence that is in his hands.
9 Who knows whether God will not turn and relent, and turn away from his fierce anger, so that we might not perish?"
10 God saw their works, that they turned from their evil way. God relented of the disaster which he said he would do to them, and he didn't do it.

4

1 But it displeased Jonah exceedingly, and he was angry.
2 He prayed to Yahweh, and said, "Please, Yahweh, wasn't this what I said when I was still in my own country? Therefore I hurried to flee to Tarshish, for I knew that you are a gracious God and merciful, slow to anger, and abundant in loving kindness, and you relent of doing harm.
3 Therefore now, Yahweh, take, I beg you, my life from me, for it is better for me to die than to live."
4 Yahweh said, "Is it right for you to be angry?"
5 Then Jonah went out of the city and sat on the east side of the city, and there made himself a booth and sat under it in the shade, until he might see what would become of the city.
6 Yahweh God prepared a vine and made it to come up over Jonah, that it might be a shade over his head to deliver him from his discomfort. So Jonah was exceedingly glad because of the vine.
7 But God prepared a worm at dawn the next day, and it chewed on the vine so that it withered.
8 When the sun arose, God prepared a sultry east wind; and the sun beat on Jonah's head, so that he was faint and requested for himself that he might die. He said, "It is better for me to die than to live."
9 God said to Jonah, "Is it right for you to be angry about the vine?"
He said, "I am right to be angry, even to death."
10 Yahweh said, "You have been concerned for the vine, for which you have not labored, neither made it grow; which came up in a night and perished in a night.

11 Shouldn’t I be concerned for Nineveh,
that great city, in which are more than
one hundred twenty thousand persons
who can’t discern between their right
hand and their left hand, and also many
animals?”

The Book of Micah

1 Yahweh's† word that came to Micah of
Morasheth in the days of Jotham, Ahaz,
and Hezekiah, kings of Judah, which he
saw concerning Samaria and Jerusalem.
2 Hear, you peoples, all of you!
Listen, O earth, and all that is therein.
Let the Lord‡ Yahweh be witness against
you,
the Lord from his holy temple.
3 For behold,§ Yahweh comes out of his
place,
and will come down and tread on the
high places of the earth.
4 The mountains melt under him,
and the valleys split apart like wax
before the fire,
like waters that are poured down a
steep place.

5 "All this is for the disobedience of Jacob,
and for the sins of the house of Israel.
What is the disobedience of Jacob?
Isn't it Samaria?
And what are the high places of Judah?
Aren't they Jerusalem?
6 Therefore I will make Samaria like a
rubble heap of the field,
like places for planting vineyards;
and I will pour down its stones into the
valley,
and I will uncover its foundations.
7 All her idols will be beaten to pieces,
all her temple gifts will be burned
with fire,
and I will destroy all her images;
for of the hire of a prostitute has she
gathered them,
and to the hire of a prostitute shall
they return."

8 For this I will lament and wail.
I will go stripped and naked.
I will howl like the jackals
and mourn like the ostriches.
9 For her wounds are incurable;
for it has come even to Judah.
It reaches to the gate of my people,
even to Jerusalem.
10 Don't tell it in Gath.
Don't weep at all.
At Beth Ophrah† I have rolled myself
in the dust.
11 Pass on, inhabitant of Shaphir, in
nakedness and shame.
The inhabitant of Zaanan won't come
out.
The wailing of Beth Ezel will take
from you his protection.
12 For the inhabitant of Maroth waits
anxiously for good,
because evil has come down from
Yahweh to the gate of Jerusalem.
13 Harness the chariot to the swift steed,
inhabitant of Lachish.
She was the beginning of sin to the
daughter of Zion;
for the transgressions of Israel were
found in you.
14 Therefore you will give a parting gift to
Moresheth Gath.
The houses of Achzib will be a
deceitful thing to the kings of Israel.
15 I will yet bring a conqueror to you,
inhabitants of Mareshah.
The glory of Israel will come to
Adullam.
16 Shave your heads,
and cut off your hair for the children
of your delight.
Enlarge your baldness like the vulture,
for they have gone into captivity from
you!

2

1 Woe to those who devise iniquity
and work evil on their beds!
When the morning is light, they practice
it,
because it is in the power of their
hand.
2 They covet fields and seize them,
and houses, then take them away.
They oppress a man and his house,

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:2** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." § **1:3** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. † **1:10** Beth Ophrah means literally "House of Dust."

even a man and his heritage.
3 Therefore Yahweh says:
"Behold, I am planning against these
people a disaster,
from which you will not remove your
necks,
neither will you walk haughtily,
for it is an evil time.
4 In that day they will take up a parable
against you,
and lament with a doleful
lamentation, saying,
'We are utterly ruined!
My people's possession is divided up.
Indeed he takes it from me and
assigns our fields to traitors!' "
5 Therefore you will have no one who
divides the land by lot in Yahweh's
assembly.
6 "Don't prophesy!"—they prophesy—
"Don't prophesy about these things.
Disgrace won't overtake us."
7 Shall it be said, O house of Jacob,
"Is Yahweh's Spirit angry?
Are these his doings?
Don't my words do good to him who
walks blamelessly?"
8 But lately my people have risen up as an
enemy.
You strip the robe and clothing from
those who pass by without a care,
returning from battle.
9 You drive the women of my people out
from their pleasant houses;
from their young children you take
away my blessing forever.
10 Arise, and depart!
For this is not your resting place,
because of uncleanness that destroys,
even with a grievous destruction.
11 If a man walking in a spirit of falsehood
lies, saying,
"I will prophesy to you of wine and of
strong drink,"
he would be the prophet of this
people.
12 I will surely assemble all of you, Jacob.
I will surely gather the remnant of
Israel.
I will put them together as the sheep of
Bozrah,
as a flock in the middle of their
pasture.
They will swarm with people.
13 He who breaks open the way goes up
before them.
They break through the gate, and go
out.
Their king passes on before them,
with Yahweh at their head.

3

1 I said,
"Please listen, you heads of Jacob,
and rulers of the house of Israel:
Isn't it for you to know justice?
2 You who hate the good,
and love the evil;
who tear off their skin,
and their flesh from off their bones;
3 who also eat the flesh of my people,
and peel their skin from off them,
and break their bones,
and chop them in pieces, as for the
pot,
and as meat within the cauldron.
4 Then they will cry to Yahweh,
but he will not answer them.
Yes, he will hide his face from them at that
time,
because they made their deeds evil."
5 Yahweh says concerning the prophets
who lead my people astray—for those who
feed their teeth, they proclaim, "Peace!"
and whoever doesn't provide for their
mouths, they prepare war against him:
6 "Therefore night is over you, with no
vision,
and it is dark to you, that you may not
divine;
and the sun will go down on the
prophets,
and the day will be black over them.
7 The seers shall be disappointed,
and the diviners confounded.
Yes, they shall all cover their lips,
for there is no answer from God."†
8 But as for me, I am full of power by
Yahweh's Spirit,
and of judgment, and of might,
to declare to Jacob his disobedience,

† **3:7** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

and to Israel his sin.
9 Please listen to this, you heads of the
house of Jacob,
and rulers of the house of Israel,
who abhor justice,
and pervert all equity,
10 who build up Zion with blood,
and Jerusalem with iniquity.
11 Her leaders judge for bribes,
and her priests teach for a price,
and her prophets of it tell fortunes for
money;
yet they lean on Yahweh, and say,
"Isn't Yahweh among us?
No disaster will come on us."
12 Therefore Zion for your sake will be
plowed like a field,
and Jerusalem will become heaps of
rubble,
and the mountain of the temple like
the high places of a forest.

4

1 But in the latter days,
it will happen that the mountain of
Yahweh's temple will be
established on the top of the
mountains,
and it will be exalted above the hills;
and peoples will stream to it.
2 Many nations will go and say,
"Come! Let's go up to the mountain of
Yahweh,
and to the house of the God of Jacob;
and he will teach us of his ways,
and we will walk in his paths."
For the law will go out of Zion,
and Yahweh's word from Jerusalem;
3 and he will judge between many peoples,
and will decide concerning strong
nations afar off.
They will beat their swords into
plowshares,
and their spears into pruning hooks.
Nation will not lift up sword against
nation,
neither will they learn war any more.
4 But every man will sit under his vine and
under his fig tree.
No one will make them afraid,
for the mouth of Yahweh of Armies
has spoken.
5 Indeed all the nations may walk in
the name of their gods,
but we will walk in the name of
Yahweh our God forever and ever.
6 "In that day," says Yahweh,
"I will assemble that which is lame,
and I will gather that which is driven
away,
and that which I have afflicted;
7 and I will make that which was lame
a remnant,
and that which was cast far off a
strong nation:
and Yahweh will reign over them on
Mount Zion from then on, even
forever."
8 You, tower of the flock, the hill of the
daughter of Zion,
to you it will come.
Yes, the former dominion will come,
the kingdom of the daughter of
Jerusalem.

9 Now why do you cry out aloud?
Is there no king in you?
Has your counselor perished,
that pains have taken hold of you as
of a woman in travail?
10 Be in pain, and labor to give birth,
daughter of Zion,
like a woman in travail;
for now you will go out of the city,
and will dwell in the field,
and will come even to Babylon.
There you will be rescued.
There Yahweh will redeem you from
the hand of your enemies.

11 Now many nations have assembled
against you, that say,
"Let her be defiled,
and let our eye gloat over Zion."
12 But they don't know the thoughts of
Yahweh,
neither do they understand his
counsel;
for he has gathered them like the
sheaves to the threshing floor.
13 Arise and thresh, daughter of Zion,
for I will make your horn iron,
and I will make your hoofs bronze.

You will beat in pieces many peoples.
I will devote their gain to Yahweh,
and their substance to the Lord of the whole earth.

5

1 Now you shall gather yourself in troops,
daughter of troops.
He has laid siege against us.
They will strike the judge of Israel
with a rod on the cheek.
2 But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah,
being small among the clans of Judah,
out of you one will come out to me
who is to be ruler in Israel;
whose goings out are from of old,
from ancient times.
3 Therefore he will abandon them until
the time that she who is in labor
gives birth.
Then the rest of his brothers will
return to the children of Israel.
4 He shall stand, and shall shepherd in the
strength of Yahweh,
in the majesty of the name of Yahweh
his God.
They will live, for then he will be
great to the ends of the earth.
5 He will be our peace when Assyria
invades our land
and when he marches through our
fortresses,
then we will raise against him seven
shepherds,
and eight leaders of men.
6 They will rule the land of Assyria with
the sword,
and the land of Nimrod in its gates.
He will deliver us from the Assyrian,
when he invades our land,
and when he marches within our
border.
7 The remnant of Jacob will be among
many peoples
like dew from Yahweh,
like showers on the grass,
that don't wait for man
nor wait for the sons of men.
8 The remnant of Jacob will be among the
nations,
among many peoples,
like a lion among the animals of the
forest,
like a young lion among the flocks of
sheep;
who, if he goes through, treads down
and tears in pieces,
and there is no one to deliver.
9 Let your hand be lifted up above your
adversaries,
and let all of your enemies be cut off.
10 "It will happen in that day", says
Yahweh,
"that I will cut off your horses from
among you
and will destroy your chariots.
11 I will cut off the cities of your land
and will tear down all your
strongholds.
12 I will destroy witchcraft from your
hand.
You shall have no soothsayers.
13 I will cut off your engraved images and
your pillars from among you;
and you shall no more worship the
work of your hands.
14 I will uproot your Asherah poles from
among you;
and I will destroy your cities.
15 I will execute vengeance in anger
and wrath on the nations that didn't
listen."

6

1 Listen now to what Yahweh says:
"Arise, plead your case before the
mountains,
and let the hills hear what you have to
say.
2 Hear, you mountains, Yahweh's
indictment,
and you enduring foundations of the
earth;
for Yahweh has a case against his
people,
and he will contend with Israel.
3 My people, what have I done to you?
How have I burdened you?
Answer me!
4 For I brought you up out of the land of
Egypt,
and redeemed you out of the house of
bondage.
I sent before you Moses, Aaron, and
Miriam.

5 My people, remember now what Balak
king of Moab devised,
and what Balaam the son of Beor
answered him from Shittim to
Gilgal,
that you may know the righteous acts
of Yahweh."

6 How shall I come before Yahweh,
and bow myself before the exalted
God?
Shall I come before him with burnt
offerings,
with calves a year old?
7 Will Yahweh be pleased with thousands
of rams?
With tens of thousands of rivers of
oil?
Shall I give my firstborn for my
disobedience?
The fruit of my body for the sin of my
soul?
8 He has shown you, O man, what is good.
What does Yahweh require of you,
but to act justly,
to love mercy, and to walk humbly
with your God?

9 Yahweh's voice calls to the city—
and wisdom fears your name—
"Listen to the rod,
and he who appointed it.
10 Are there yet treasures of wickedness in
the house of the wicked,
and a short ephah† that is accursed?
11 Shall I tolerate dishonest scales,
and a bag of deceitful weights?
12 Her rich men are full of violence,
her inhabitants speak lies,
and their tongue is deceitful in their
speech.
13 Therefore I also have struck you with a
grievous wound.
I have made you desolate because of
your sins.
14 You shall eat, but not be satisfied.
Your hunger will be within you.
You will store up, but not save,
and that which you save I will give up
to the sword.
15 You will sow, but won't reap.
You will tread the olives, but won't
anoint yourself with oil;
and crush grapes, but won't drink the
wine.
16 For the statutes of Omri are kept,
and all the works of Ahab's house.
You walk in their counsels,
that I may make you a ruin,
and your inhabitants a hissing.
You will bear the reproach of my
people."

7

1 Misery is mine!
Indeed, I am like one who gathers the
summer fruits, as gleanings of the
vineyard.
There is no cluster of grapes to eat.
My soul desires to eat the early fig.
2 The godly man has perished out of the
earth,
and there is no one upright among
men.
They all lie in wait for blood;
every man hunts his brother with a
net.
3 Their hands are on that which is evil to
do it diligently.
The ruler and judge ask for a bribe.
The powerful man dictates the evil desire
of his soul.
Thus they conspire together.
4 The best of them is like a brier.
The most upright is worse than a
thorn hedge.
The day of your watchmen,
even your visitation, has come;
now is the time of their confusion.
5 Don't trust in a neighbor.
Don't put confidence in a friend.
With the woman lying in your
embrace,
be careful of the words of your
mouth!
6 For the son dishonors the father,
the daughter rises up against her
mother,
the daughter-in-law against her
mother-in-law;

† **6:10** An ephah is a measure of volume (about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel), and a short ephah is made smaller than a full ephah for the purpose of cheating customers.

a man's enemies are the men of his own house.
7 But as for me, I will look to Yahweh.
I will wait for the God of my salvation.
My God will hear me.
8 Don't rejoice against me, my enemy.
When I fall, I will arise.
When I sit in darkness, Yahweh will be a light to me.
9 I will bear the indignation of Yahweh,
because I have sinned against him,
until he pleads my case and executes judgment for me.
He will bring me out to the light.
I will see his righteousness.
10 Then my enemy will see it,
and shame will cover her who said to me,
"Where is Yahweh your God?"
My eyes will see her.
Now she will be trodden down like the mire of the streets.
11 A day to build your walls!
In that day, he will extend your boundary.
12 In that day they will come to you from Assyria and the cities of Egypt,
and from Egypt even to the River,
and from sea to sea,
and mountain to mountain.
13 Yet the land will be desolate because of those who dwell therein,
for the fruit of their doings.
14 Shepherd your people with your staff,
the flock of your heritage,
who dwell by themselves in a forest.
Let them feed in the middle of fertile pasture land,
in Bashan and Gilead, as in the days of old.
15 "As in the days of your coming out of the land of Egypt,
I will show them marvelous things."
16 The nations will see and be ashamed of all their might.
They will lay their hand on their mouth.
Their ears will be deaf.
17 They will lick the dust like a serpent.
Like crawling things of the earth, they will come trembling out of their dens.
They will come with fear to Yahweh our God,
and will be afraid because of you.
18 Who is a God like you, who pardons iniquity,
and passes over the disobedience of the remnant of his heritage?
He doesn't retain his anger forever,
because he delights in loving kindness.
19 He will again have compassion on us.
He will tread our iniquities under foot.
You will cast all their sins into the depths of the sea.
20 You will give truth to Jacob,
and mercy to Abraham,
as you have sworn to our fathers from the days of old.

The Book of Nahum

1 A revelation about Nineveh. The book
of the vision of Nahum the Elkoshite.
2 Yahweh† is a jealous God‡ and
avenges. Yahweh avenges and is full of
wrath. Yahweh takes vengeance on his
adversaries, and he maintains wrath
against his enemies.
3 Yahweh is slow to anger, and great in
power, and will by no means leave the
guilty unpunished. Yahweh has his way in
the whirlwind and in the storm, and the
clouds are the dust of his feet.
4 He rebukes the sea and makes it dry,
and dries up all the rivers. Bashan and
Carmel languish. The flower of Lebanon
languishes.
5 The mountains quake before him, and
the hills melt away. The earth trembles at
his presence, yes, the world, and all who
dwell in it.
6 Who can stand before his indignation?
Who can endure the fierceness of his
anger? His wrath is poured out like fire,
and the rocks are broken apart by him.
7 Yahweh is good, a stronghold in the
day of trouble; and he knows those who
take refuge in him.
8 But with an overflowing flood, he will
make a full end of her place, and will
pursue his enemies into darkness.
9 What do you plot against Yahweh? He
will make a full end. Affliction won't rise
up the second time.
10 For entangled like thorns, and
drunken as with their drink, they are
consumed utterly like dry stubble.
11 One has gone out of you who devises
evil against Yahweh, who counsels
wickedness.
12 Yahweh says: "Though they are in full
strength and likewise many, even so they
will be cut down and pass away. Though I
have afflicted you, I will afflict you no
more.
13 Now I will break his yoke from off
you, and will burst your bonds apart."
14 Yahweh has commanded concerning
you: "No more descendants will bear your
name. Out of the house of your gods, I will
cut off the engraved image and the molten
image. I will make your grave, for you are
vile."
15 Behold,§ on the mountains the feet of
him who brings good news, who
publishes peace! Keep your feasts, Judah!
Perform your vows, for the wicked one
will no more pass through you. He is
utterly cut off.

2

1 He who dashes in pieces has come up
against you. Keep the fortress! Watch the
way! Strengthen your waist! Fortify your
power mightily!
2 For Yahweh restores the excellency of
Jacob as the excellency of Israel, for the
destroyers have destroyed them and
ruined their vine branches.
3 The shield of his mighty men is made
red. The valiant men are in scarlet. The
chariots flash with steel in the day of his
preparation, and the pine spears are
brandished.
4 The chariots rage in the streets. They
rush back and forth in the wide ways.
Their appearance is like torches. They run
like the lightnings.
5 He summons his picked troops. They
stumble on their way. They dash to its
wall, and the protective shield is put in
place.
6 The gates of the rivers are opened, and
the palace is dissolved.
7 It is decreed: she is uncovered, she is
carried away; and her servants moan as
with the voice of doves, beating on their
breasts.
8 But Nineveh has been from of old like
a pool of water, yet they flee away. "Stop!
Stop!" they cry, but no one looks back.
9 Take the plunder of silver. Take the
plunder of gold, for there is no end of

† **1:2** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:2** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). § **1:15** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

treasure, an abundance of every precious thing.
10 She is empty, void, and waste. The heart melts, the knees knock together, their bodies and faces have grown pale.
11 Where is the den of the lions, and the feeding place of the young lions, where the lion and the lioness walked with the lion's cubs, and no one made them afraid?
12 The lion tore in pieces enough for his cubs, and strangled prey for his lionesses, and filled his caves with the kill and his dens with prey.
13 "Behold, I am against you," says Yahweh of Armies, "and I will burn her chariots in the smoke, and the sword will devour your young lions; and I will cut off your prey from the earth, and the voice of your messengers will no longer be heard."

3

1 Woe to the bloody city! It is all full of lies and robbery—no end to the prey.
2 The noise of the whip, the noise of the rattling of wheels, prancing horses, and bounding chariots,
3 the horseman charging, and the flashing sword, the glittering spear, and a multitude of slain, and a great heap of corpses, and there is no end of the bodies. They stumble on their bodies
4 because of the multitude of the prostitution of the alluring prostitute, the mistress of witchcraft, who sells nations through her prostitution, and families through her witchcraft.
5 "Behold, I am against you," says Yahweh of Armies, "and I will lift your skirts over your face. I will show the nations your nakedness, and the kingdoms your shame.
6 I will throw abominable filth on you and make you vile, and will make you a spectacle.
7 It will happen that all those who look at you will flee from you, and say, 'Nineveh is laid waste! Who will mourn for her?' Where will I seek comforters for you?"
8 Are you better than No-Amon,† who was situated among the rivers,‡ who had the waters around her, whose rampart was the sea, and her wall was of the sea?
9 Cush and Egypt were her boundless strength. Put and Libya were her helpers.
10 Yet was she carried away. She went into captivity. Her young children also were dashed in pieces at the head of all the streets, and they cast lots for her honorable men, and all her great men were bound in chains.
11 You also will be drunken. You will be hidden. You also will seek a stronghold because of the enemy.
12 All your fortresses will be like fig trees with the first-ripe figs. If they are shaken, they fall into the mouth of the eater.
13 Behold, your troops among you are women. The gates of your land are set wide open to your enemies. The fire has devoured your bars.
14 Draw water for the siege. Strengthen your fortresses. Go into the clay, and tread the mortar. Make the brick kiln strong.
15 There the fire will devour you. The sword will cut you off. It will devour you like the grasshopper. Multiply like grasshoppers. Multiply like the locust.
16 You have increased your merchants more than the stars of the skies. The grasshopper strips and flees away.
17 Your guards are like the locusts, and your officials like the swarms of locusts, which settle on the walls on a cold day, but when the sun appears, they flee away, and their place is not known where they are.
18 Your shepherds slumber, king of Assyria. Your nobles lie down. Your people are scattered on the mountains, and there is no one to gather them.
19 There is no healing your wound, for your injury is fatal. All who hear the report of you clap their hands over you, for who hasn't felt your endless cruelty?

† **3:8** or, Thebes ‡ **3:8** or, Nile

The Book of Habakkuk

1 The revelation which Habakkuk the
prophet saw.
2 Yahweh,† how long will I cry, and you
will not hear? I cry out to you "Violence!"
and will you not save?
3 Why do you show me iniquity, and
look at perversity? For destruction and
violence are before me. There is strife,
and contention rises up.
4 Therefore the law is paralyzed, and
justice never prevails; for the wicked
surround the righteous; therefore justice
comes out perverted.
5 "Look among the nations, watch, and
wonder marvelously; for I am working a
work in your days which you will not
believe though it is told you.
6 For, behold,‡ I am raising up the
Chaldeans, that bitter and hasty nation
who march through the width of the
earth, to possess dwelling places that are
not theirs.
7 They are feared and dreaded. Their
judgment and their dignity proceed from
themselves.
8 Their horses also are swifter than
leopards, and are more fierce than the
evening wolves. Their horsemen press
proudly on. Yes, their horsemen come
from afar. They fly as an eagle that
hurries to devour.
9 All of them come for violence. Their
hordes face forward. They gather
prisoners like sand.
10 Yes, they scoff at kings, and princes
are a derision to them. They laugh at
every stronghold, for they build up an
earthen ramp and take it.
11 Then they sweep by like the wind and
go on. They are indeed guilty, whose
strength is their god."
12 Aren't you from everlasting, Yahweh
my God,§ my Holy One? We will not die.
Yahweh, you have appointed them for
judgment. You, Rock, have established
him to punish.
13 You who have purer eyes than to see
evil, and who cannot look on perversity,
why do you tolerate those who deal
treacherously and keep silent when the
wicked swallows up the man who is more
righteous than he,
14 and make men like the fish of the sea,
like the creeping things that have no ruler
over them?
15 He takes up all of them with the hook.
He catches them in his net and gathers
them in his dragnet. Therefore he rejoices
and is glad.
16 Therefore he sacrifices to his net and
burns incense to his dragnet, because by
them his life is luxurious and his food is
good.
17 Will he therefore continually empty
his net, and kill the nations without
mercy?

2

1 I will stand at my watch and set myself
on the ramparts, and will look out to see
what he will say to me, and what I will
answer concerning my complaint.
2 Yahweh answered me, "Write the
vision, and make it plain on tablets, that
he who runs may read it.
3 For the vision is yet for the appointed
time, and it hurries toward the end, and
won't prove false. Though it takes time,
wait for it, because it will surely come. It
won't delay.
4 Behold, his soul is puffed up. It is not
upright in him, but the righteous will live
by his faith.
5 Yes, moreover, wine is treacherous: an
arrogant man who doesn't stay at home,
who enlarges his desire as Sheol;† he is
like death and can't be satisfied, but
gathers to himself all nations and heaps to
himself all peoples.
6 Won't all these take up a parable
against him, and a taunting proverb

† **1:2** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:6** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. § **1:12** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). † **2:5** Sheol is the place of the dead.

against him, and say, ‘Woe to him who increases that which is not his, and who enriches himself by extortion! How long?’
7 Won’t your debtors rise up suddenly,
and wake up those who make you tremble, and you will be their victim?
8 Because you have plundered many nations, all the remnant of the peoples will plunder you because of men’s blood, and for the violence done to the land, to the city and to all who dwell in it.
9 Woe to him who gets an evil gain for his house, that he may set his nest on high, that he may be delivered from the hand of evil!
10 You have devised shame to your house by cutting off many peoples, and have sinned against your soul.
11 For the stone will cry out of the wall, and the beam out of the woodwork will answer it.
12 Woe to him who builds a town with blood, and establishes a city by iniquity!
13 Behold, isn’t it from Yahweh of Armies that the peoples labor for the fire, and the nations weary themselves for vanity?
14 For the earth will be filled with the knowledge of Yahweh’s glory, as the waters cover the sea.
15 “Woe to him who gives his neighbor drink, pouring your inflaming wine until they are drunk, so that you may gaze at their naked bodies!
16 You are filled with shame, and not glory. You will also drink and be exposed! The cup of Yahweh’s right hand will come around to you, and disgrace will cover your glory.
17 For the violence done to Lebanon will overwhelm you, and the destruction of the animals will terrify you, because of men’s blood and for the violence done to the land, to every city and to those who dwell in them.
18 “What value does the engraved image have, that its maker has engraved it; the molten image, even the teacher of lies, that he who fashions its form trusts in it, to make mute idols?
19 Woe to him who says to the wood, ‘Awake!’ or to the mute stone, ‘Arise!’
Shall this teach? Behold, it is overlaid with gold and silver, and there is no breath at all within it.
20 But Yahweh is in his holy temple. Let all the earth be silent before him!”

3

1 A prayer of Habakkuk, the prophet, set to victorious music.
2 Yahweh, I have heard of your fame.
I stand in awe of your deeds, Yahweh.
Renew your work in the middle of the years.
In the middle of the years make it known.
In wrath, you remember mercy.
3 God came from Teman,
the Holy One from Mount Paran.
Selah.

His glory covered the heavens,
and his praise filled the earth.
4 His splendor is like the sunrise.
Rays shine from his hand, where his power is hidden.
5 Plague went before him,
and pestilence followed his feet.
6 He stood, and shook the earth.
He looked, and made the nations tremble.
The ancient mountains were crumbled.
The age-old hills collapsed.
His ways are eternal.
7 I saw the tents of Cushan in affliction.
The dwellings of the land of Midian trembled.
8 Was Yahweh displeased with the rivers?
Was your anger against the rivers,
or your wrath against the sea,
that you rode on your horses,
on your chariots of salvation?
9 You uncovered your bow.
You called for your sworn arrows.
Selah.
You split the earth with rivers.
10 The mountains saw you, and were afraid.
The storm of waters passed by.
The deep roared and lifted up its hands on high.
11 The sun and moon stood still in the sky

at the light of your arrows as they
went,
at the shining of your glittering spear.
12 You marched through the land in wrath.
You threshed the nations in anger.
13 You went out for the salvation of your
people,
for the salvation of your anointed.
You crushed the head of the land of
wickedness.
You stripped them head to foot.
Selah.

14 You pierced the heads of his warriors
with their own spears.
They came as a whirlwind to scatter
me,
gloating as if to devour the wretched
in secret.
15 You trampled the sea with your horses,
churning mighty waters.
16 I heard, and my body trembled.
My lips quivered at the voice.
Rottenness enters into my bones, and I
tremble in my place
because I must wait quietly for the
day of trouble,
for the coming up of the people who
invade us.
17 For even though the fig tree doesn't
flourish,
nor fruit be in the vines,
the labor of the olive fails,
the fields yield no food,
the flocks are cut off from the fold,
and there is no herd in the stalls,
18 yet I will rejoice in Yahweh.
I will be joyful in the God of my
salvation!
19 Yahweh, the Lord,† is my strength.
He makes my feet like deer's feet,
and enables me to go in high places.
For the music director, on my stringed
instruments.

† **3:19** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai."

The Book of Zephaniah

1 Yahweh's† word which came to
Zephaniah, the son of Cushi, the son of
Gedaliah, the son of Amariah, the son of
Hezekiah, in the days of Josiah, the son of
Amon, king of Judah.
2 I will utterly sweep away everything
from the surface of the earth, says
Yahweh.
3 I will sweep away man and animal. I
will sweep away the birds of the sky, the
fish of the sea, and the heaps of rubble
with the wicked. I will cut off man from
the surface of the earth, says Yahweh.
4 I will stretch out my hand against
Judah and against all the inhabitants of
Jerusalem. I will cut off the remnant of
Baal from this place—the name of the
idolatrous and pagan priests,
5 those who worship the army of the sky
on the housetops, those who worship and
swear by Yahweh and also swear by
Malcam,
6 those who have turned back from
following Yahweh, and those who haven't
sought Yahweh nor inquired after him.
7 Be silent at the presence of the Lord‡
Yahweh, for the day of Yahweh is at hand.
For Yahweh has prepared a sacrifice. He
has consecrated his guests.
8 It will happen in the day of Yahweh's
sacrifice that I will punish the princes, the
king's sons, and all those who are clothed
with foreign clothing.
9 In that day, I will punish all those who
leap over the threshold, who fill their
master's house with violence and deceit.
10 In that day, says Yahweh, there will
be the noise of a cry from the fish gate, a
wailing from the second quarter, and a
great crashing from the hills.
11 Wail, you inhabitants of Maktesh, for
all the people of Canaan are undone! All
those who were loaded with silver are cut
off.
12 It will happen at that time, that I will
search Jerusalem with lamps, and I will
punish the men who are settled on their
dregs, who say in their heart, "Yahweh
will not do good, neither will he do evil."
13 Their wealth will become a plunder,
and their houses a desolation. Yes, they
will build houses, but won't inhabit them.
They will plant vineyards, but won't drink
their wine.
14 The great day of Yahweh is near. It is
near and hurries greatly, the voice of the
day of Yahweh. The mighty man cries
there bitterly.
15 That day is a day of wrath, a day of
distress and anguish, a day of trouble and
ruin, a day of darkness and gloom, a day
of clouds and blackness,
16 a day of the trumpet and alarm
against the fortified cities and against the
high battlements.
17 I will bring such distress on men that
they will walk like blind men because
they have sinned against Yahweh. Their
blood will be poured out like dust and
their flesh like dung.
18 Neither their silver nor their gold will
be able to deliver them in the day of
Yahweh's wrath, but the whole land will
be devoured by the fire of his jealousy; for
he will make an end, yes, a terrible end, of
all those who dwell in the land.

2

1 Gather yourselves together, yes,
gather together, you nation that has no
shame,
2 before the appointed time when the
day passes as the chaff, before the fierce
anger of Yahweh comes on you, before the
day of Yahweh's anger comes on you.
3 Seek Yahweh, all you humble of the
land, who have kept his ordinances. Seek
righteousness. Seek humility. It may be
that you will be hidden in the day of
Yahweh's anger.
4 For Gaza will be forsaken, and
Ashkelon a desolation. They will drive out

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:7** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai."

Ashdod at noonday, and Ekron will be rooted up.
5 Woe to the inhabitants of the sea coast, the nation of the Cherethites! Yahweh's word is against you, Canaan, the land of the Philistines. I will destroy you until there is no inhabitant.
6 The sea coast will be pastures, with cottages for shepherds and folds for flocks.
7 The coast will be for the remnant of the house of Judah. They will find pasture. In the houses of Ashkelon, they will lie down in the evening, for Yahweh, their God,† will visit them and restore them.
8 I have heard the reproach of Moab and the insults of the children of Ammon, with which they have reproached my people and magnified themselves against their border.
9 Therefore, as I live, says Yahweh of Armies, the God of Israel, surely Moab will be as Sodom, and the children of Ammon as Gomorrah, a possession of nettles and salt pits, and a perpetual desolation. The remnant of my people will plunder them, and the survivors of my nation will inherit them.
10 This they will have for their pride, because they have reproached and magnified themselves against the people of Yahweh of Armies.
11 Yahweh will be awesome to them, for he will famish all the gods of the land. Men will worship him, everyone from his place, even all the shores of the nations.
12 You Cushites also, you will be killed by my sword.
13 He will stretch out his hand against the north, destroy Assyria, and will make Nineveh a desolation, as dry as the wilderness.
14 Herds will lie down in the middle of her, all kinds of animals. Both the pelican and the porcupine will lodge in its capitals. Their calls will echo through the windows. Desolation will be in the thresholds, for he has laid bare the cedar beams.
15 This is the joyous city that lived carelessly, that said in her heart, "I am, and there is no one besides me." How she has become a desolation, a place for animals to lie down in! Everyone who passes by her will hiss and shake their fists.

3

1 Woe to her who is rebellious and polluted, the oppressing city!
2 She didn't obey the voice. She didn't receive correction. She didn't trust in Yahweh. She didn't draw near to her God.
3 Her princes within her are roaring lions. Her judges are evening wolves. They leave nothing until the next day.
4 Her prophets are arrogant and treacherous people. Her priests have profaned the sanctuary. They have done violence to the law.
5 Yahweh, within her, is righteous. He will do no wrong. Every morning he brings his justice to light. He doesn't fail, but the unjust know no shame.
6 I have cut off nations. Their battlements are desolate. I have made their streets waste, so that no one passes by. Their cities are destroyed, so that there is no man, so that there is no inhabitant.
7 I said, "Just fear me. Receive correction," so that her dwelling won't be cut off, according to all that I have appointed concerning her. But they rose early and corrupted all their doings.
8 "Therefore wait for me", says Yahweh, "until the day that I rise up to the prey, for my determination is to gather the nations, that I may assemble the kingdoms to pour on them my indignation, even all my fierce anger, for all the earth will be devoured with the fire of my jealousy.
9 For then I will purify the lips of the peoples, that they may all call on Yahweh's name, to serve him shoulder to shoulder.
10 From beyond the rivers of Cush, my worshipers, even the daughter of my dispersed people, will bring my offering.
11 In that day you will not be disappointed for all your doings in which you have transgressed against me; for then I will take away out from among you

† **2:7** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

your proudly exulting ones, and you will
no more be arrogant in my holy
mountain.
12 But I will leave among you an
afflicted and poor people, and they will
take refuge in Yahweh's name.
13 The remnant of Israel will not do
iniquity nor speak lies, neither will a
deceitful tongue be found in their mouth,
for they will feed and lie down, and no
one will make them afraid."
14 Sing, daughter of Zion! Shout, Israel!
Be glad and rejoice with all your heart,
daughter of Jerusalem.
15 Yahweh has taken away your
judgments. He has thrown out your
enemy. The King of Israel, Yahweh, is
among you. You will not be afraid of evil
any more.
16 In that day, it will be said to
Jerusalem, "Don't be afraid, Zion. Don't let
your hands be weak."
17 Yahweh, your God, is among you, a
mighty one who will save. He will rejoice
over you with joy. He will calm you in his
love. He will rejoice over you with
singing.
18 I will remove those who grieve about
the appointed feasts from you. They are a
burden and a reproach to you.
19 Behold,† at that time I will deal with
all those who afflict you; and I will save
those who are lame and gather those who
were driven away. I will give them praise
and honor, whose shame has been in all
the earth.
20 At that time I will bring you in, and at
that time I will gather you; for I will give
you honor and praise among all the
peoples of the earth when I restore your
fortunes before your eyes, says Yahweh.

† **3:19** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

The Book of Haggai

1 In the second year of Darius the king, in the sixth month, in the first day of the month, Yahweh's† word came by Haggai the prophet, to Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest, saying,
2 "This is what Yahweh of Armies says: These people say, 'The time hasn't yet come, the time for Yahweh's house to be built.' "
3 Then Yahweh's word came by Haggai the prophet, saying,
4 "Is it a time for you yourselves to dwell in your paneled houses, while this house lies waste?
5 Now therefore this is what Yahweh of Armies says: 'Consider your ways.
6 You have sown much, and bring in little. You eat, but you don't have enough. You drink, but you aren't filled with drink. You clothe yourselves, but no one is warm; and he who earns wages earns wages to put them into a bag with holes in it.'
7 "This is what Yahweh of Armies says: 'Consider your ways.
8 Go up to the mountain, bring wood, and build the house. I will take pleasure in it, and I will be glorified," says Yahweh.
9 "You looked for much, and, behold,‡ it came to little; and when you brought it home, I blew it away. Why?" says Yahweh of Armies, "Because of my house that lies waste, while each of you is busy with his own house.
10 Therefore for your sake the heavens withhold the dew, and the earth withholds its fruit.
11 I called for a drought on the land, on the mountains, on the grain, on the new wine, on the oil, on that which the ground produces, on men, on livestock, and on all the labor of the hands."
12 Then Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel and Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest, with all the remnant of the people, obeyed Yahweh their God's§ voice, and the words of Haggai the prophet, as Yahweh their God had sent him; and the people feared Yahweh.
13 Then Haggai, Yahweh's messenger, spoke Yahweh's message to the people, saying, "I am with you," says Yahweh.
14 Yahweh stirred up the spirit of Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and the spirit of Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest, and the spirit of all the remnant of the people; and they came and worked on the house of Yahweh of Armies, their God,
15 in the twenty-fourth day of the month, in the sixth month, in the second year of Darius the king.

2

1 In the seventh month, in the twenty-first day of the month, Yahweh's word came by Haggai the prophet, saying,
2 "Speak now to Zerubbabel the son of Shealtiel, governor of Judah, and to Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest, and to the remnant of the people, saying,
3 'Who is left among you who saw this house in its former glory? How do you see it now? Isn't it in your eyes as nothing?
4 Yet now be strong, Zerubbabel,' says Yahweh. 'Be strong, Joshua son of Jehozadak, the high priest. Be strong, all you people of the land,' says Yahweh, 'and work, for I am with you,' says Yahweh of Armies.
5 This is the word that I covenanted with you when you came out of Egypt, and my Spirit lived among you. 'Don't be afraid.'
6 For this is what Yahweh of Armies says: 'Yet once more, it is a little while, and I will shake the heavens, the earth, the sea, and the dry land;
7 and I will shake all nations. The treasure of all nations will come, and I

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:9** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. § **1:12** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

will fill this house with glory, says Yahweh of Armies.
8 The silver is mine, and the gold is mine,' says Yahweh of Armies.
9 'The latter glory of this house will be greater than the former,' says Yahweh of Armies; 'and in this place I will give peace,' says Yahweh of Armies."
10 In the twenty-fourth day of the ninth month, in the second year of Darius, Yahweh's word came by Haggai the prophet, saying,
11 "Yahweh of Armies says: Ask now the priests concerning the law, saying,
12 'If someone carries holy meat in the fold of his garment, and with his fold touches bread, stew, wine, oil, or any food, will it become holy?' "
The priests answered, "No."
13 Then Haggai said, "If one who is unclean by reason of a dead body touches any of these, will it be unclean?"
The priests answered, "It will be unclean."
14 Then Haggai answered, " 'So is this people, and so is this nation before me,' says Yahweh; 'and so is every work of their hands. That which they offer there is unclean.
15 Now, please consider from this day and backward, before a stone was laid on a stone in Yahweh's temple.
16 Through all that time, when one came to a heap of twenty measures, there were only ten. When one came to the wine vat to draw out fifty, there were only twenty.
17 I struck you with blight, mildew, and hail in all the work of your hands; yet you didn't turn to me,' says Yahweh.
18 'Consider, please, from this day and backward, from the twenty-fourth day of the ninth month, since the day that the foundation of Yahweh's temple was laid, consider it.
19 Is the seed yet in the barn? Yes, the vine, the fig tree, the pomegranate, and the olive tree haven't produced. From today I will bless you.' "
20 Yahweh's word came the second time to Haggai in the twenty-fourth day of the month, saying,
21 "Speak to Zerubbabel, governor of Judah, saying, 'I will shake the heavens and the earth.
22 I will overthrow the throne of kingdoms. I will destroy the strength of the kingdoms of the nations. I will overthrow the chariots and those who ride in them. The horses and their riders will come down, everyone by the sword of his brother.
23 In that day, says Yahweh of Armies, I will take you, Zerubbabel my servant, the son of Shealtiel,' says Yahweh, 'and will make you like a signet ring, for I have chosen you,' says Yahweh of Armies."

The Book of Zechariah

1 In the eighth month, in the second
year of Darius, Yahweh's† word came to
the prophet Zechariah the son of
Berechiah, the son of Iddo, saying,
2 "Yahweh was very displeased with
your fathers.
3 Therefore tell them, Yahweh of Armies
says: 'Return to me,' says Yahweh of
Armies, 'and I will return to you,' says
Yahweh of Armies.
4 Don't you be like your fathers, to
whom the former prophets proclaimed,
saying: Yahweh of Armies says, 'Return
now from your evil ways and from your
evil doings;' but they didn't hear nor listen
to me, says Yahweh.
5 Your fathers, where are they? And the
prophets, do they live forever?
6 But my words and my decrees, which I
commanded my servants the prophets,
didn't they overtake your fathers?
"Then they repented and said, 'Just as
Yahweh of Armies determined to do to us,
according to our ways and according to
our practices, so he has dealt with us.' "
7 On the twenty-fourth day of the
eleventh month, which is the month
Shebat, in the second year of Darius,
Yahweh's word came to the prophet
Zechariah the son of Berechiah, the son of
Iddo, saying,
8 "I had a vision in the night, and
behold,‡ a man riding on a red horse, and
he stood among the myrtle trees that were
in a ravine; and behind him there were
red, brown, and white horses.
9 Then I asked, 'My lord, what are
these?' "
The angel who talked with me said to
me, "I will show you what these are."
10 The man who stood among the myrtle
trees answered, "They are the ones
Yahweh has sent to go back and forth
through the earth."
11 They reported to Yahweh's angel who
stood among the myrtle trees, and said,
"We have walked back and forth through
the earth, and behold, all the earth is at
rest and in peace."
12 Then Yahweh's angel replied, "O
Yahweh of Armies, how long will you not
have mercy on Jerusalem and on the cities
of Judah, against which you have had
indignation these seventy years?"
13 Yahweh answered the angel who
talked with me with kind and comforting
words.
14 So the angel who talked with me said
to me, "Proclaim, saying, 'Yahweh of
Armies says: "I am jealous for Jerusalem
and for Zion with a great jealousy.
15 I am very angry with the nations that
are at ease; for I was but a little
displeased, but they added to the
calamity."
16 Therefore Yahweh says: "I have
returned to Jerusalem with mercy. My
house shall be built in it," says Yahweh of
Armies, "and a line shall be stretched out
over Jerusalem." '
17 "Proclaim further, saying, 'Yahweh of
Armies says: "My cities will again
overflow with prosperity, and Yahweh
will again comfort Zion, and will again
choose Jerusalem." ' "
18 I lifted up my eyes and saw, and
behold, four horns.
19 I asked the angel who talked with me,
"What are these?"
He answered me, "These are the horns
which have scattered Judah, Israel, and
Jerusalem."
20 Yahweh showed me four craftsmen.
21 Then I asked, "What are these coming
to do?"
He said, "These are the horns which
scattered Judah, so that no man lifted up
his head; but these have come to terrify
them, to cast down the horns of the
nations that lifted up their horn against
the land of Judah to scatter it."

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:8** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

2

1 I lifted up my eyes, and saw, and
behold, a man with a measuring line in
his hand.
2 Then I asked, “Where are you going?”
He said to me, “To measure Jerusalem,
to see what is its width and what is its
length.”
3 Behold, the angel who talked with me
went out, and another angel went out to
meet him,
4 and said to him, “Run, speak to this
young man, saying, ‘Jerusalem will be
inhabited as villages without walls,
because of the multitude of men and
livestock in it.
5 For I,’ says Yahweh, ‘will be to her a
wall of fire around it, and I will be the
glory in the middle of her.
6 Come! Come! Flee from the land of the
north,’ says Yahweh; ‘for I have spread
you abroad as the four winds of the sky,’
says Yahweh.
7 ‘Come, Zion! Escape, you who dwell
with the daughter of Babylon.’
8 For Yahweh of Armies says: ‘For honor
he has sent me to the nations which
plundered you; for he who touches you
touches the apple of his eye.
9 For, behold, I will shake my hand over
them, and they will be a plunder to those
who served them; and you will know that
Yahweh of Armies has sent me.
10 Sing and rejoice, daughter of Zion!
For behold, I come and I will dwell within
you,’ says Yahweh.
11 Many nations shall join themselves to
Yahweh in that day, and shall be my
people; and I will dwell among you, and
you shall know that Yahweh of Armies
has sent me to you.
12 Yahweh will inherit Judah as his
portion in the holy land, and will again
choose Jerusalem.
13 Be silent, all flesh, before Yahweh; for
he has roused himself from his holy
habitation!”

3

1 He showed me Joshua the high priest
standing before Yahweh’s angel, and
Satan standing at his right hand to be his
adversary.
2 Yahweh said to Satan, “Yahweh rebuke
you, Satan! Yes, Yahweh who has chosen
Jerusalem rebuke you! Isn’t this a burning
stick plucked out of the fire?”
3 Now Joshua was clothed with filthy
garments, and was standing before the
angel.
4 He answered and spoke to those who
stood before him, saying, “Take the filthy
garments off him.” To him he said,
“Behold, I have caused your iniquity to
pass from you, and I will clothe you with
rich clothing.”
5 I said, “Let them set a clean turban on
his head.”
So they set a clean turban on his head,
and clothed him; and Yahweh’s angel was
standing by.
6 Yahweh’s angel solemnly assured
Joshua, saying,
7 “Yahweh of Armies says: ‘If you will
walk in my ways, and if you will follow
my instructions, then you also shall judge
my house, and shall also keep my courts,
and I will give you a place of access
among these who stand by.
8 Hear now, Joshua the high priest, you
and your fellows who sit before you, for
they are men who are a sign; for, behold, I
will bring out my servant, the Branch.
9 For, behold, the stone that I have set
before Joshua: on one stone are seven
eyes; behold, I will engrave its
inscription,’ says Yahweh of Armies, ‘and I
will remove the iniquity of that land in
one day.
10 In that day,’ says Yahweh of Armies,
‘you will invite every man his neighbor
under the vine and under the fig tree.’ ”

4

1 The angel who talked with me came
again and wakened me, as a man who is
wakened out of his sleep.
2 He said to me, “What do you see?”
I said, “I have seen, and behold, a lamp
stand all of gold, with its bowl on the top
of it, and its seven lamps on it; there are

seven pipes to each of the lamps which
are on the top of it;
3 and two olive trees by it, one on the
right side of the bowl, and the other on the
left side of it."
4 I answered and spoke to the angel who
talked with me, saying, "What are these,
my lord?"
5 Then the angel who talked with me
answered me, "Don't you know what
these are?"
I said, "No, my lord."
6 Then he answered and spoke to me,
saying, "This is Yahweh's word to
Zerubbabel, saying, 'Not by might, nor by
power, but by my Spirit,' says Yahweh of
Armies.
7 Who are you, great mountain? Before
Zerubbabel you are a plain; and he will
bring out the capstone with shouts of
'Grace, grace, to it!' "
8 Moreover Yahweh's word came to me,
saying,
9 "The hands of Zerubbabel have laid
the foundation of this house. His hands
shall also finish it; and you will know that
Yahweh of Armies has sent me to you.
10 Indeed, who despises the day of small
things? For these seven shall rejoice, and
shall see the plumb line in the hand of
Zerubbabel. These are Yahweh's eyes,
which run back and forth through the
whole earth."
11 Then I asked him, "What are these
two olive trees on the right side of the
lamp stand and on the left side of it?"
12 I asked him the second time, "What
are these two olive branches, which are
beside the two golden spouts that pour the
golden oil out of themselves?"
13 He answered me, "Don't you know
what these are?"
I said, "No, my lord."
14 Then he said, "These are the two
anointed ones who stand by the Lord† of
the whole earth."

5

1 Then again I lifted up my eyes and
saw, and behold, a flying scroll.
2 He said to me, "What do you see?"
I answered, "I see a flying scroll; its
length is twenty cubits,† and its width ten
cubits."
3 Then he said to me, "This is the curse
that goes out over the surface of the whole
land, for everyone who steals shall be cut
off according to it on the one side; and
everyone who swears falsely shall be cut
off according to it on the other side.
4 I will cause it to go out," says Yahweh
of Armies, "and it will enter into the house
of the thief, and into the house of him who
swears falsely by my name; and it will
remain in the middle of his house, and
will destroy it with its timber and its
stones."
5 Then the angel who talked with me
came forward and said to me, "Lift up
now your eyes and see what this is that is
appearing."
6 I said, "What is it?"
He said, "This is the ephah‡ basket that
is appearing." He said moreover, "This is
their appearance in all the land—
7 and behold, a lead cover weighing one
talent§ was lifted up—and there was a
woman sitting in the middle of the ephah†
basket."
8 He said, "This is Wickedness;" and he
threw her down into the middle of the
ephah basket; and he threw the lead
weight on its mouth.
9 Then I lifted up my eyes and saw, and
behold, there were two women; and the
wind was in their wings. Now they had
wings like the wings of a stork, and they
lifted up the ephah basket between earth
and the sky.
10 Then I said to the angel who talked
with me, "Where are these carrying the
ephah basket?"
11 He said to me, "To build her a house
in the land of Shinar. When it is prepared,
she will be set there in her own place."

† **4:14** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." † **5:2** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters. ‡ **5:6** An ephah is a measure of volume of about 22 liters, 5.8 U. S. gallons, or about 2/3 of a bushel. § **5:7** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds. † **5:7** 1 ephah is about 22 liters or about 2/3 of a bushel

6

1 Again I lifted up my eyes, and saw, and behold, four chariots came out from between two mountains; and the mountains were mountains of bronze.
2 In the first chariot were red horses. In the second chariot were black horses.
3 In the third chariot were white horses. In the fourth chariot were dappled horses, all of them powerful.
4 Then I asked the angel who talked with me, "What are these, my lord?"
5 The angel answered me, "These are the four winds of the sky, which go out from standing before the Lord of all the earth.
6 The one with the black horses goes out toward the north country; and the white went out after them; and the dappled went out toward the south country."
7 The strong went out, and sought to go that they might walk back and forth through the earth. He said, "Go around and through the earth!" So they walked back and forth through the earth.
8 Then he called to me, and spoke to me, saying, "Behold, those who go toward the north country have quieted my spirit in the north country."
9 Yahweh's word came to me, saying,
10 "Take of them of the captivity, even of Heldai, of Tobijah, and of Jedaiah; and come the same day, and go into the house of Josiah the son of Zephaniah, where they have come from Babylon.
11 Yes, take silver and gold, and make crowns, and set them on the head of Joshua the son of Jehozadak, the high priest;
12 and speak to him, saying, 'Yahweh of Armies says, "Behold, the man whose name is the Branch! He will grow up out of his place; and he will build Yahweh's temple.
13 He will build Yahweh's temple. He will bear the glory, and will sit and rule on his throne. He will be a priest on his throne. The counsel of peace will be between them both.
14 The crowns shall be to Helem, to Tobijah, to Jedaiah, and to Hen the son of Zephaniah, for a memorial in Yahweh's temple.
15 Those who are far off shall come and build in Yahweh's temple; and you shall know that Yahweh of Armies has sent me to you. This will happen, if you will diligently obey Yahweh your God's voice." ' "†

7

1 In the fourth year of King Darius, Yahweh's word came to Zechariah in the fourth day of the ninth month, the month of Chislev.
2 The people of Bethel sent Sharezer and Regem Melech and their men to entreat Yahweh's favor,
3 and to speak to the priests of the house of Yahweh of Armies and to the prophets, saying, "Should I weep in the fifth month, separating myself, as I have done these so many years?"
4 Then the word of Yahweh of Armies came to me, saying,
5 "Speak to all the people of the land and to the priests, saying, 'When you fasted and mourned in the fifth and in the seventh month for these seventy years, did you at all fast to me, really to me?
6 When you eat and when you drink, don't you eat for yourselves and drink for yourselves?
7 Aren't these the words which Yahweh proclaimed by the former prophets when Jerusalem was inhabited and in prosperity, and its cities around her, and the South and the lowland were inhabited?' "
8 Yahweh's word came to Zechariah, saying,
9 "Thus has Yahweh of Armies spoken, saying, 'Execute true judgment, and show kindness and compassion every man to his brother.
10 Don't oppress the widow, the fatherless, the foreigner, nor the poor; and let none of you devise evil against his brother in your heart.'
11 But they refused to listen, and turned their backs, and stopped their ears, that they might not hear.

† **6:15** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim).

12 Yes, they made their hearts as hard as
flint, lest they might hear the law and the
words which Yahweh of Armies had sent
by his Spirit by the former prophets.
Therefore great wrath came from Yahweh
of Armies.
13 It has come to pass that, as he called
and they refused to listen, so they will call
and I will not listen," said Yahweh of
Armies;
14 "but I will scatter them with a
whirlwind among all the nations which
they have not known. Thus the land was
desolate after them, so that no man
passed through nor returned; for they
made the pleasant land desolate."

8

1 The word of Yahweh of Armies came
to me.
2 Yahweh of Armies says: "I am jealous
for Zion with great jealousy, and I am
jealous for her with great wrath."
3 Yahweh says: "I have returned to Zion,
and will dwell in the middle of Jerusalem.
Jerusalem shall be called 'The City of
Truth;' and the mountain of Yahweh of
Armies, 'The Holy Mountain.' "
4 Yahweh of Armies says: "Old men and
old women will again dwell in the streets
of Jerusalem, every man with his staff in
his hand because of their old age.
5 The streets of the city will be full of
boys and girls playing in its streets."
6 Yahweh of Armies says: "If it is
marvelous in the eyes of the remnant of
this people in those days, should it also be
marvelous in my eyes?" says Yahweh of
Armies.
7 Yahweh of Armies says: "Behold, I will
save my people from the east country and
from the west country.
8 I will bring them, and they will dwell
within Jerusalem. They will be my people,
and I will be their God, in truth and in
righteousness."
9 Yahweh of Armies says: "Let your
hands be strong, you who hear in these
days these words from the mouth of the
prophets who were in the day that the
foundation of the house of Yahweh of
Armies was laid, even the temple, that it
might be built.
10 For before those days there was no
wages for man nor any wages for an
animal, neither was there any peace to
him who went out or came in, because of
the adversary. For I set all men everyone
against his neighbor.
11 But now I will not be to the remnant
of this people as in the former days," says
Yahweh of Armies.
12 "For the seed of peace and the vine
will yield its fruit, and the ground will
give its increase, and the heavens will
give their dew. I will cause the remnant of
this people to inherit all these things.
13 It shall come to pass that, as you were
a curse among the nations, house of Judah
and house of Israel, so I will save you, and
you shall be a blessing. Don't be afraid.
Let your hands be strong."

14 For Yahweh of Armies says: "As I
thought to do evil to you when your
fathers provoked me to wrath," says
Yahweh of Armies, "and I didn't repent,
15 so again I have thought in these days
to do good to Jerusalem and to the house
of Judah. Don't be afraid.
16 These are the things that you shall do:
speak every man the truth with his
neighbor. Execute the judgment of truth
and peace in your gates,
17 and let none of you devise evil in your
hearts against his neighbor, and love no
false oath; for all these are things that I
hate," says Yahweh.

18 The word of Yahweh of Armies came
to me.
19 Yahweh of Armies says: "The fasts of
the fourth, fifth, seventh, and tenth
months shall be for the house of Judah
joy, gladness, and cheerful feasts.
Therefore love truth and peace."

20 Yahweh of Armies says: "Many
peoples and the inhabitants of many cities
will yet come.
21 The inhabitants of one will go to
another, saying, 'Let's go speedily to
entreat the favor of Yahweh, and to seek
Yahweh of Armies. I will go also.'

22 Yes, many peoples and strong nations
will come to seek Yahweh of Armies in
Jerusalem and to entreat the favor of
Yahweh."
23 Yahweh of Armies says: "In those
days, ten men out of all the languages of
the nations will take hold of the skirt of
him who is a Jew, saying, 'We will go with
you, for we have heard that God is with
you.' "

9

1 A revelation.
Yahweh's word is against the land of
Hadrach,
and will rest upon Damascus—
for the eye of man
and of all the tribes of Israel is toward
Yahweh—
2 and Hamath, also, which borders on it,
Tyre and Sidon, because they are very
wise.
3 Tyre built herself a stronghold,
and heaped up silver like the dust,
and fine gold like the mire of the
streets.
4 Behold, the Lord will dispossess her,
and he will strike her power in the
sea;
and she will be devoured with fire.

5 Ashkelon will see it, and fear;
Gaza also, and will writhe in agony;
as will Ekron, for her expectation will
be disappointed;
and the king will perish from Gaza,
and Ashkelon will not be inhabited.
6 Foreigners will dwell in Ashdod,
and I will cut off the pride of the
Philistines.
7 I will take away his blood out of his
mouth,
and his abominations from between
his teeth;
and he also will be a remnant for our God;
and he will be as a chieftain in Judah,
and Ekron as a Jebusite.
8 I will encamp around my house against
the army,
that no one pass through or return;
and no oppressor will pass through
them any more:
for now I have seen with my eyes.
9 Rejoice greatly, daughter of Zion!
Shout, daughter of Jerusalem!
Behold, your King comes to you!
He is righteous, and having salvation;
lowly, and riding on a donkey,
even on a colt, the foal of a donkey.
10 I will cut off the chariot from Ephraim
and the horse from Jerusalem.
The battle bow will be cut off;
and he will speak peace to the
nations.
His dominion will be from sea to sea,
and from the River to the ends of the
earth.

11 As for you also,
because of the blood of your
covenant,
I have set free your prisoners from
the pit in which is no water.
12 Turn to the stronghold, you prisoners of
hope!
Even today I declare that I will restore
double to you.
13 For indeed I bend Judah as a bow for
me.
I have loaded the bow with Ephraim.
I will stir up your sons, Zion,
against your sons, Greece,
and will make you like the sword of a
mighty man.

14 Yahweh will be seen over them.
His arrow will flash like lightning.
The Lord Yahweh will blow the trumpet,
and will go with whirlwinds of the
south.
15 Yahweh of Armies will defend them.
They will destroy and overcome with
sling stones.
They will drink, and roar as through wine.
They will be filled like bowls,
like the corners of the altar.

16 Yahweh their God will save them in that
day as the flock of his people;
for they are like the jewels of a crown,
lifted on high over his land.
17 For how great is his goodness,
and how great is his beauty!
Grain will make the young men flourish,
and new wine the virgins.

10

1 Ask of Yahweh rain in the spring time,
Yahweh who makes storm clouds,
and he gives rain showers to
everyone for the plants in the field.
2 For the teraphim† have spoken vanity,
and the diviners have seen a lie;
and they have told false dreams.
They comfort in vain.
Therefore they go their way like
sheep.
They are oppressed, because there is
no shepherd.

3 My anger is kindled against the
shepherds,
and I will punish the male goats,
for Yahweh of Armies has visited his
flock, the house of Judah,
and will make them as his majestic
horse in the battle.
4 From him will come the cornerstone,
from him the tent peg,
from him the battle bow,
from him every ruler together.
5 They will be as mighty men,
treading down muddy streets in the
battle.
They will fight, because Yahweh is with
them.
The riders on horses will be
confounded.

6 "I will strengthen the house of Judah,
and I will save the house of Joseph.
I will bring them back,
for I have mercy on them.
They will be as though I had not cast them
off,
for I am Yahweh their God, and I will
hear them.
7 Ephraim will be like a mighty man,
and their heart will rejoice as through
wine.
Yes, their children will see it and rejoice.
Their heart will be glad in Yahweh.
8 I will signal for them and gather them,
for I have redeemed them.
They will increase as they were
before.
9 I will sow them among the peoples.
They will remember me in far
countries.
They will live with their children and
will return.
10 I will bring them again also out of the
land of Egypt,
and gather them out of Assyria.
I will bring them into the land of Gilead
and Lebanon;
and there won't be room enough for
them.
11 He will pass through the sea of
affliction,
and will strike the waves in the sea,
and all the depths of the Nile will dry
up;
and the pride of Assyria will be
brought down,
and the scepter of Egypt will depart.
12 I will strengthen them in Yahweh.
They will walk up and down in his
name," says Yahweh.

11

1 Open your doors, Lebanon,
that the fire may devour your cedars.
2 Wail, cypress tree, for the cedar has
fallen,
because the stately ones are
destroyed.
Wail, you oaks of Bashan,
for the strong forest has come down.
3 A voice of the wailing of the shepherds!
For their glory is destroyed—a voice of
the roaring of young lions!
For the pride of the Jordan is ruined.
4 Yahweh my God says: "Feed the flock
of slaughter.
5 Their buyers slaughter them and go
unpunished. Those who sell them say,
'Blessed be Yahweh, for I am rich;' and
their own shepherds don't pity them.
6 For I will no more pity the inhabitants
of the land," says Yahweh; "but, behold, I
will deliver every one of the men into his
neighbor's hand and into the hand of his
king. They will strike the land, and out of
their hand I will not deliver them."
7 So I fed the flock to be slaughtered,
especially the oppressed of the flock. I

† **10:2** teraphim were household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

took for myself two staffs. The one I called
“Favor” and the other I called “Union”,
and I fed the flock.
8 I cut off the three shepherds in one
month; for my soul was weary of them,
and their soul also loathed me.
9 Then I said, “I will not feed you. That
which dies, let it die; and that which is to
be cut off, let it be cut off; and let those
who are left eat each other’s flesh.”
10 I took my staff Favor and cut it apart,
that I might break my covenant that I had
made with all the peoples.
11 It was broken in that day; and thus
the poor of the flock that listened to me
knew that it was Yahweh’s word.
12 I said to them, “If you think it best,
give me my wages; and if not, keep them.”
So they weighed for my wages thirty
pieces of silver.
13 Yahweh said to me, “Throw it to the
potter—the handsome price that I was
valued at by them!” I took the thirty
pieces of silver and threw them to the
potter in Yahweh’s house.
14 Then I cut apart my other staff, Union,
that I might break the brotherhood
between Judah and Israel.
15 Yahweh said to me, “Take for yourself
yet again the equipment of a foolish
shepherd.
16 For, behold, I will raise up a shepherd
in the land who will not visit those who
are cut off, neither will seek those who are
scattered, nor heal that which is broken,
nor feed that which is sound; but he will
eat the meat of the fat sheep, and will tear
their hoofs in pieces.
17 Woe to the worthless shepherd who
leaves the flock! The sword will strike his
arm and his right eye. His arm will be
completely withered, and his right eye
will be totally blinded!”

12

1 A revelation of Yahweh’s word
concerning Israel: Yahweh, who stretches
out the heavens and lays the foundation
of the earth, and forms the spirit of man
within him says:
2 “Behold, I will make Jerusalem a cup
of reeling to all the surrounding peoples,
and it will also be on Judah in the siege
against Jerusalem.
3 It will happen in that day that I will
make Jerusalem a burdensome stone for
all the peoples. All who burden
themselves with it will be severely
wounded, and all the nations of the earth
will be gathered together against it.
4 In that day,” says Yahweh, “I will strike
every horse with terror and his rider with
madness. I will open my eyes on the
house of Judah, and will strike every
horse of the peoples with blindness.
5 The chieftains of Judah will say in
their heart, ‘The inhabitants of Jerusalem
are my strength in Yahweh of Armies
their God.’
6 In that day I will make the chieftains of
Judah like a pan of fire among wood, and
like a flaming torch among sheaves. They
will devour all the surrounding peoples
on the right hand and on the left; and
Jerusalem will yet again dwell in their
own place, even in Jerusalem.
7 Yahweh also will save the tents of
Judah first, that the glory of David’s house
and the glory of the inhabitants of
Jerusalem not be magnified above Judah.
8 In that day Yahweh will defend the
inhabitants of Jerusalem. He who is feeble
among them at that day will be like David,
and David’s house will be like God, like
Yahweh’s angel before them.
9 It will happen in that day, that I will
seek to destroy all the nations that come
against Jerusalem.
10 I will pour on David’s house and on
the inhabitants of Jerusalem the spirit of
grace and of supplication. They will look
to me† whom they have pierced; and they
shall mourn for him as one mourns for his
only son, and will grieve bitterly for him
as one grieves for his firstborn.
11 In that day there will be a great
mourning in Jerusalem, like the mourning
of Hadadrimmon in the valley of Megiddo.

† **12:10** After “me”, the Hebrew has the two letters “Aleph Tav” (the first and last letters of the Hebrew alphabet), not as a word, but as a grammatical marker.

12 The land will mourn, every family
apart; the family of David's house apart,
and their wives apart; the family of the
house of Nathan apart, and their wives
apart;
13 the family of the house of Levi apart,
and their wives apart; the family of the
Shimeites apart, and their wives apart;
14 all the families who remain, every
family apart, and their wives apart.

13

1 "In that day there will be a fountain
opened to David's house and to the
inhabitants of Jerusalem, for sin and for
uncleanness.
2 It will come to pass in that day, says
Yahweh of Armies, that I will cut off the
names of the idols out of the land, and
they will be remembered no more. I will
also cause the prophets and the spirit of
impurity to pass out of the land.
3 It will happen that when anyone still
prophesies, then his father and his mother
who bore him will tell him, 'You must die,
because you speak lies in Yahweh's name;'
and his father and his mother who bore
him will stab him when he prophesies.
4 It will happen in that day that the
prophets will each be ashamed of his
vision when he prophesies; they won't
wear a hairy mantle to deceive,
5 but he will say, 'I am no prophet, I am a
tiller of the ground; for I have been made
a bondservant from my youth.'
6 One will say to him, 'What are these
wounds between your arms?' Then he
will answer, 'Those with which I was
wounded in the house of my friends.'

7 "Awake, sword, against my shepherd,
and against the man who is close to
me," says Yahweh of Armies.
"Strike the shepherd, and the sheep will
be scattered;
and I will turn my hand against the
little ones.
8 It shall happen that in all the land," says
Yahweh,
"two parts in it will be cut off and die;
but the third will be left in it.
9 I will bring the third part into the fire,
and will refine them as silver is
refined,
and will test them like gold is tested.
They will call on my name, and I will hear
them.
I will say, 'It is my people;'
and they will say, 'Yahweh is my
God.' "

14

1 Behold, a day of Yahweh comes, when
your plunder will be divided within you.
2 For I will gather all nations against
Jerusalem to battle; and the city will be
taken, the houses rifled, and the women
ravished. Half of the city will go out into
captivity, and the rest of the people will
not be cut off from the city.
3 Then Yahweh will go out and fight
against those nations, as when he fought
in the day of battle.
4 His feet will stand in that day on the
Mount of Olives, which is before
Jerusalem on the east; and the Mount of
Olives will be split in two from east to
west, making a very great valley. Half of
the mountain will move toward the north,
and half of it toward the south.
5 You shall flee by the valley of my
mountains, for the valley of the
mountains shall reach to Azel. Yes, you
shall flee, just like you fled from before
the earthquake in the days of Uzziah king
of Judah. Yahweh my God will come, and
all the holy ones with you.†
6 It will happen in that day that there
will not be light, cold, or frost.
7 It will be a unique day which is known
to Yahweh—not day, and not night; but it
will come to pass that at evening time
there will be light.
8 It will happen in that day that living
waters will go out from Jerusalem, half of
them toward the eastern sea, and half of
them toward the western sea. It will be so
in summer and in winter.
9 Yahweh will be King over all the earth.
In that day Yahweh will be one, and his
name one.

† **14:5** Septuagint reads "him" instead of "you".

10 All the land will be made like the
Arabah, from Geba to Rimmon south of
Jerusalem; and she will be lifted up and
will dwell in her place, from Benjamin's
gate to the place of the first gate, to the
corner gate, and from the tower of
Hananel to the king's wine presses.
11 Men will dwell therein, and there will
be no more curse; but Jerusalem will
dwell safely.
12 This will be the plague with which
Yahweh will strike all the peoples who
have fought against Jerusalem: their flesh
will consume away while they stand on
their feet, and their eyes will consume
away in their sockets, and their tongue
will consume away in their mouth.
13 It will happen in that day that a great
panic from Yahweh will be among them;
and they will each seize the hand of his
neighbor, and his hand will rise up
against the hand of his neighbor.
14 Judah also will fight at Jerusalem; and
the wealth of all the surrounding nations
will be gathered together: gold, silver, and
clothing, in great abundance.
15 A plague like this will fall on the
horse, on the mule, on the camel, on the
donkey, and on all the animals that will be
in those camps.
16 It will happen that everyone who is
left of all the nations that came against
Jerusalem will go up from year to year to
worship the King, Yahweh of Armies, and
to keep the feast of booths.
17 It will be that whoever of all the
families of the earth doesn't go up to
Jerusalem to worship the King, Yahweh of
Armies, on them there will be no rain.
18 If the family of Egypt doesn't go up
and doesn't come, neither will it rain on
them. This will be the plague with which
Yahweh will strike the nations that don't
go up to keep the feast of booths.
19 This will be the punishment of Egypt
and the punishment of all the nations that
don't go up to keep the feast of booths.
20 In that day there will be inscribed on
the bells of the horses, "HOLY TO
YAHWEH"; and the pots in Yahweh's
house will be like the bowls before the
altar.
21 Yes, every pot in Jerusalem and in
Judah will be holy to Yahweh of Armies;
and all those who sacrifice will come and
take of them, and cook in them. In that
day there will no longer be a Canaanite‡ in
the house of Yahweh of Armies.

‡ **14:21** or, merchant

The Book of Malachi

1 A revelation, Yahweh's† word to Israel
by Malachi.
2 "I have loved you," says Yahweh.
Yet you say, "How have you loved us?"
"Wasn't Esau Jacob's brother?" says
Yahweh, "Yet I loved Jacob;
3 but Esau I hated, and made his
mountains a desolation, and gave his
heritage to the jackals of the wilderness."
4 Whereas Edom says, "We are beaten
down, but we will return and build the
waste places," Yahweh of Armies says,
"They shall build, but I will throw down;
and men will call them 'The Wicked Land,'
even the people against whom Yahweh
shows wrath forever."
5 Your eyes will see, and you will say,
"Yahweh is great—even beyond the
border of Israel!"
6 "A son honors his father, and a servant
his master. If I am a father, then where is
my honor? And if I am a master, where is
the respect due me?" says Yahweh of
Armies to you priests who despise my
name. "You say, 'How have we despised
your name?'
7 You offer polluted bread on my altar.
You say, 'How have we polluted you?' In
that you say, 'Yahweh's table is
contemptible.'
8 When you offer the blind for sacrifice,
isn't that evil? And when you offer the
lame and sick, isn't that evil? Present it
now to your governor! Will he be pleased
with you? Or will he accept your person?"
says Yahweh of Armies.
9 "Now, please entreat the favor of God,‡
that he may be gracious to us. With this,
will he accept any of you?" says Yahweh
of Armies.
10 "Oh that there were one among you
who would shut the doors, that you might
not kindle fire on my altar in vain! I have
no pleasure in you," says Yahweh of
Armies, "neither will I accept an offering
at your hand.
11 For from the rising of the sun even to
its going down, my name is great among
the nations, and in every place incense
will be offered to my name, and a pure
offering; for my name is great among the
nations," says Yahweh of Armies.
12 "But you profane it when you say,
'Yahweh's table is polluted, and its fruit,
even its food, is contemptible.'
13 You say also, 'Behold,§ what a
weariness it is!' And you have sniffed at
it", says Yahweh of Armies; "and you have
brought that which was taken by violence,
the lame, and the sick; thus you bring the
offering. Should I accept this at your
hand?" says Yahweh.
14 "But the deceiver is cursed who has in
his flock a male, and vows and sacrifices
to the Lord† a defective thing; for I am a
great King," says Yahweh of Armies, "and
my name is awesome among the nations."

2

1 "Now, you priests, this commandment
is for you.
2 If you will not listen, and if you will not
take it to heart, to give glory to my name,"
says Yahweh of Armies, "then I will send
the curse on you, and I will curse your
blessings. Indeed, I have cursed them
already, because you do not take it to
heart.
3 Behold, I will rebuke your offspring,†
and will spread dung on your faces, even
the dung of your feasts; and you will be
taken away with it.
4 You will know that I have sent this
commandment to you, that my covenant
may be with Levi," says Yahweh of
Armies.
5 "My covenant was with him of life and
peace; and I gave them to him that he
might be reverent toward me; and he was
reverent toward me, and stood in awe of
my name.

† **1:1** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations. ‡ **1:9** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). § **1:13** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. † **1:14** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." † **2:3** or, seed

6 The law of truth was in his mouth, and
unrighteousness was not found in his lips.
He walked with me in peace and
uprightness, and turned many away from
iniquity.
7 For the priest's lips should keep
knowledge, and they should seek the law
at his mouth; for he is the messenger of
Yahweh of Armies.
8 But you have turned away from the
path. You have caused many to stumble in
the law. You have corrupted the covenant
of Levi," says Yahweh of Armies.
9 "Therefore I have also made you
contemptible and wicked before all the
people, according to the way you have not
kept my ways, but have had respect for
persons in the law.
10 Don't we all have one father? Hasn't
one God created us? Why do we deal
treacherously every man against his
brother, profaning the covenant of our
fathers?
11 Judah has dealt treacherously, and an
abomination is committed in Israel and in
Jerusalem; for Judah has profaned the
holiness of Yahweh which he loves, and
has married the daughter of a foreign god.
12 Yahweh will cut off the man who does
this, him who wakes and him who
answers, out of the tents of Jacob and him
who offers an offering to Yahweh of
Armies.
13 "This again you do: you cover
Yahweh's altar with tears, with weeping,
and with sighing, because he doesn't
regard the offering any more, neither
receives it with good will at your hand.
14 Yet you say, 'Why?' Because Yahweh
has been witness between you and the
wife of your youth, against whom you
have dealt treacherously, though she is
your companion and the wife of your
covenant.
15 Did he not make you one, although he
had the residue of the Spirit? Why one?
He sought godly offspring. Therefore take
heed to your spirit, and let no one deal
treacherously against the wife of his
youth.
16 One who hates and divorces", says
Yahweh, the God of Israel, "covers his
garment with violence!" says Yahweh of
Armies. "Therefore pay attention to your
spirit, that you don't be unfaithful.
17 You have wearied Yahweh with your
words. Yet you say, 'How have we wearied
him?' In that you say, 'Everyone who does
evil is good in Yahweh's sight, and he
delights in them;' or 'Where is the God of
justice?'

3

1 "Behold, I send my messenger, and he
will prepare the way before me! The Lord,
whom you seek, will suddenly come to his
temple. Behold, the messenger of the
covenant, whom you desire, is coming!"
says Yahweh of Armies.
2 "But who can endure the day of his
coming? And who will stand when he
appears? For he is like a refiner's fire, and
like launderers' soap;
3 and he will sit as a refiner and purifier
of silver, and he will purify the sons of
Levi, and refine them as gold and silver;
and they shall offer to Yahweh offerings
in righteousness.
4 Then the offering of Judah and
Jerusalem will be pleasant to Yahweh as
in the days of old and as in ancient years.
5 I will come near to you to judgment. I
will be a swift witness against the
sorcerers, against the adulterers, against
the perjurers, and against those who
oppress the hireling in his wages, the
widow, and the fatherless, and who
deprive the foreigner of justice, and don't
fear me," says Yahweh of Armies.
6 "For I, Yahweh, don't change; therefore
you, sons of Jacob, are not consumed.
7 From the days of your fathers you
have turned away from my ordinances
and have not kept them. Return to me,
and I will return to you," says Yahweh of
Armies. "But you say, 'How shall we
return?'
8 Will a man rob God? Yet you rob me!
But you say, 'How have we robbed you?'
In tithes and offerings.
9 You are cursed with the curse; for you
rob me, even this whole nation.

10 Bring the whole tithe into the
storehouse, that there may be food in my
house, and test me now in this," says
Yahweh of Armies, "if I will not open you
the windows of heaven, and pour you out
a blessing, that there will not be enough
room for.
11 I will rebuke the devourer for your
sakes, and he shall not destroy the fruits
of your ground; neither shall your vine
cast its fruit before its time in the field,"
says Yahweh of Armies.
12 "All nations shall call you blessed, for
you will be a delightful land," says
Yahweh of Armies.
13 "Your words have been harsh against
me," says Yahweh. "Yet you say, 'What
have we spoken against you?'
14 You have said, 'It is vain to serve God,'
and 'What profit is it that we have
followed his instructions and that we
have walked mournfully before Yahweh
of Armies?
15 Now we call the proud happy; yes,
those who work wickedness are built up;
yes, they tempt God, and escape.'
16 Then those who feared Yahweh spoke
one with another; and Yahweh listened
and heard, and a book of memory was
written before him for those who feared
Yahweh and who honored his name.
17 They shall be mine," says Yahweh of
Armies, "my own possession in the day
that I make. I will spare them, as a man
spares his own son who serves him.
18 Then you shall return and discern
between the righteous and the wicked,
between him who serves God and him
who doesn't serve him.

4

1 "For behold, the day comes, burning
like a furnace, when all the proud and all
who work wickedness will be stubble. The
day that comes will burn them up," says
Yahweh of Armies, "so that it will leave
them neither root nor branch.
2 But to you who fear my name shall the
sun of righteousness arise with healing in
its wings. You will go out and leap like
calves of the stall.
3 You shall tread down the wicked; for
they will be ashes under the soles of your
feet in the day that I make," says Yahweh
of Armies.
4 "Remember the law of Moses my
servant, which I commanded to him in
Horeb for all Israel, even statutes and
ordinances.
5 Behold, I will send you Elijah the
prophet before the great and terrible day
of Yahweh comes.
6 He will turn the hearts of the fathers to
the children and the hearts of the children
to their fathers, lest I come and strike the
earth with a curse."

Tobit

Tobit is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches.

1 The book of the words of Tobit, the son
of Tobiel, the son of Ananiel, the son of
Aduel, the son of Gabael, of the seed of
Asiel, of the tribe of Naphtali;
2 who in the days of Enemessar† king of
the Assyrians was carried away captive
out of Thisbe, which is on the right hand
of Kedesh Naphtali in Galilee above Asher.
3 I, Tobit walked in the ways of truth and
righteousness all the days of my life, and I
did many alms deeds to my kindred and
my nation, who went with me into the
land of the Assyrians, to Nineveh.
4 When I was in my own country, in the
land of Israel, while I was yet young, all
the tribe of Naphtali my father fell away
from the house of Jerusalem, which was
chosen out of all the tribes of Israel, that
all the tribes should sacrifice there, and
the temple of the habitation of the Most
High was hallowed and built therein for
all ages.
5 All the tribes which fell away together
sacrificed to the heifer Baal, and so did the
house of Naphtali my father.
6 I alone went often to Jerusalem at the
feasts, as it has been ordained to all Israel
by an everlasting decree, having the first
fruits and the tenths of my increase, and
that which was first shorn; and I gave
them at the altar to the priests the sons of
Aaron.
7 I gave a tenth part of all my increase to
the sons of Levi, who ministered at
Jerusalem. A second tenth part I sold
away, and went, and spent it each year at
Jerusalem.
8 A third tenth I gave to them to whom it
was appropriate, as Deborah my father's
mother had commanded me, because I
was left an orphan by my father.
9 When I became a man, I took as wife
Anna of the seed of our own family. With
her, I became the father of Tobias.
10 When I was carried away captive to
Nineveh, all my kindred and my relatives
ate of the bread of the Gentiles;
11 but I kept myself from eating,
12 because I remembered God with all
my soul.
13 So the Most High gave me grace and
favor‡ in the sight of Enemessar, and I was
his purchasing agent.
14 And I went into Media, and left ten
talents of silver in trust with Gabael, the
brother of Gabrias, at Rages of Media.
15 And when Enemessar was dead,
Sennacherib his son reigned in his place.
In his time, the highways were troubled,§
and I could no longer go into Media.
16 In the days of Enemessar, I did many
alms deeds to my kindred: I gave my
bread to the hungry,
17 and my garments to the naked. If I
saw any of my race dead, and thrown out
on† the wall of Ninevah, I buried him.
18 If Sennacherib the king killed any,
when he came fleeing from Judea, I
buried them privately; for in his wrath he
killed many; and the bodies were sought
for by the king, and were not found.
19 But one of the Ninevites went and
showed to the king concerning me, how I
buried them, and hid myself; and when I
knew that I was sought for to be put to
death, I withdrew myself for fear.
20 And all my goods were forcibly taken
away, and there was nothing left to me,
save my wife Anna and my son Tobias.
21 No more than fifty five days passed
before two of his sons killed him, and they
fled into the mountains of Ararat. And
Sarchedonus‡ his son reigned in his place;
and he appointed Achiacharus my
brother Anael's son over all the accounts
of his kingdom, and over all his affairs.
22 Achiacharus requested me, and I
came to Nineveh. Now Achiacharus was
cupbearer, keeper of the signet, steward,
and overseer of the accounts.

† **1:2** That is, *Shalmaneser.* Compare 2 Kings 17:3, 23. ‡ **1:13** Gr. *beauty.* § **1:15** Gr. *his highways were troubled.*
† **1:17** Some ancient authorities read *behind.* ‡ **1:21** That is, *Esar-haddon,* and so in verse 22.

Sarchedonus appointed him next to himself, but he was my brother's son.

2

1 Now when I had come home again,
and my wife Anna was restored to me,
and my son Tobias, in the feast of
Pentecost, which is the holy feast of the
seven weeks, there was a good dinner
prepared for me, and I sat down to eat.
2 I saw abundance of meat, and I said to
my son, "Go and bring whatever poor man
you find of our kindred, who is mindful of
the Lord. Behold, I wait for you."
3 Then he came, and said, "Father, one
of our race is strangled, and has been cast
out in the marketplace."
4 Before I had tasted anything, I sprang
up, and took him up into a chamber until
the sun had set.
5 Then I returned, washed myself, ate
my bread in heaviness,
6 and remembered the prophecy of
Amos, as he said,
*"Your feasts will be turned into
mourning,
and all your mirth into lamentation.
7 So I wept: and when the sun had set, I
went and dug a grave, and buried him.
8 My neighbors mocked me, and said,
"He is no longer afraid to be put to death
for this matter; and yet he fled away.
Behold, he buries the dead again."
9 The same night I returned from
burying him, and slept by the wall of my
courtyard, being polluted; and my face
was uncovered.
10 I didn't know that there were
sparrows in the wall. My eyes were open
and the sparrows dropped warm dung
into my eyes, and white films came over
my eyes. I went to the physicians, and
they didn't help me; but Achiacharus
nourished me, until I went† into Elymais.
11 My wife Anna wove cloth in the
women's chambers,
12 and sent the work back to the owners.
They on their part paid her wages, and
also gave her a kid.
13 But when it came to my house, it
began to cry, and I said to her, "Where did
this kid come from? Is it stolen? Give it
back to the owners; for it is not lawful to
eat anything that is stolen."
14 But she said, "It has been given to me
for a gift more than the wages."
I didn't believe her, and I asked her to
return it to the owners; and I was
ashamed of her.
But she answered and said to me,
"Where are your alms and your righteous
deeds? Behold, you and all your works
are known.‡"

3

1 I was grieved and wept, and prayed in
sorrow, saying,
2 "O Lord, you are righteous, and all
your works and all your ways are mercy
and truth, and you judge true and
righteous judgment forever.
3 Remember me, and look at me. Don't
take vengeance on me for my sins and my
ignorances, and the sins of my fathers
who sinned before you.
4 For they disobeyed your
commandments. You gave us as plunder,
for captivity, for death, and for a proverb
of reproach to all the nations among
whom we are dispersed.
5 Now your judgments are many and
true, that you should deal with me
according to my sins and the sins of my
fathers, because we didn't keep your
commandments, for we didn't walk in
truth before you.
6 Now deal with me according to that
which is pleasing in your sight. Command
my spirit to be taken from me, that I may
be released, and become earth. For it is
more profitable for me to die rather than
to live, because I have heard false
reproaches, and there is much sorrow in
me. Command that I be released from my
distress, now, and go to the everlasting
place. Don't turn your face away from
me."
7 The same day it happened to Sarah the
daughter of Raguel in Ecbatana of Media,

* **2:6** Amos 8:10 † **2:10** Some authorities read *until he went.* ‡ **2:14** Gr. *all things are known with you.*

that she also was reproached by her father's maidservants;
8 because that she had been given to seven husbands, and Asmodaeus the evil spirit† killed them, before they had lain with her. And they said to her, "Do you not know that you strangle your husbands? You have had already seven husbands, and you haven't borne the name of any one of them.
9 Why do you scourge us? If they are dead, go your ways with them. Let us never see either son or daughter from you."
10 When she heard these things, she was grieved exceedingly, so that she thought about hanging herself. Then she said, "I am the only daughter of my father. If I do this, it will be a reproach to him, and I will bring down his old age with sorrow to the grave.‡"
11 Then she prayed by the window, and said, "Blessed are you, O Lord my God, and blessed is your holy and honorable name forever! Let all your works praise you forever!
12 And now, Lord, I have set my eyes and my face toward you.
13 Command that I be released from the earth, and that I no longer hear reproach.
14 You know, Lord, that I am pure from all sin with man,
15 and that I never polluted my name or the name of my father in the land of my captivity. I am the only daughter of my father, and he has no child that will be his heir, nor brother near him, nor son belonging to him, that I should keep myself for a wife to him. Seven husbands of mine are dead already. Why should I live? If it doesn't please you to kill me, command some regard to be had of me, and pity taken of me, and that I hear no more reproach."
16 The prayer of both was heard before the glory of the great God.
17 Raphael also was sent to heal them both, to scale away the white films from Tobit's eyes, and to give Sarah the daughter of Raguel for a wife to Tobias the son of Tobit; and to bind Asmodaeus the evil spirit§; because it belonged to Tobias that he should inherit her. At that very time, Tobit returned and entered into his house, and Sarah the daughter of Raguel came down from her upper chamber.

4

1 In that day Tobit remembered the money which he had left in trust with Gabael in Rages of Media,
2 and he said to himself, I have asked for death; why do I not call my son Tobias, that I may explain to him about the money before I die?
3 And he called him, and said,
"My child, if I die, bury me. Don't despise your mother. Honor her all the days of your life, and do that which is pleasing to her, and don't grieve her.
4 Remember, my child, that she has seen many dangers for you, when you were in her womb. When she is dead, bury her by me in one grave.
5 My child, be mindful of the Lord our God all your days, and don't let your will be set to sin and to transgress his commandments: do righteousness all the days of your life, and don't follow the ways of unrighteousness.
6 For if you do what is true, your deeds will prosperously succeed for you, and for all those who do righteousness.
7 Give alms from your possessions. When you give alms, don't let your eye be envious. Don't turn away your face from any poor man, and the face of God won't be turned away from you.
8 As your possessions are, give alms of it according to your abundance. If you have little, don't be afraid to give alms according to that little;
9 for you lay up a good treasure for yourself against the day of necessity;
10 because alms-giving delivers from death, and doesn't allow you to come into darkness.

† **3:8** Gr. *demon.* ‡ **3:10** Gr. *Hades.* § **3:17** Gr. *demon.*

11 Alms is a good gift in the sight of the
Most High for all that give it.
12 Beware, my child, of all fornication,
and take first a wife of the seed of your
fathers. Don't take a strange wife, who is
not of your father's tribe; for we are the
descendants of the prophets. Remember,
my child, that Noah, Abraham, Isaac, and
Jacob, our fathers of old time, all took
wives of their kindred, and were blessed
in their children, and their seed will
inherit the land.
13 And now, my child, love your kindred,
and don't scorn your kindred and the sons
and the daughters of your people in your
heart, to take a wife of them; for in
scornfulness is destruction and much
trouble, and in idleness is decay and great
lack; for idleness is the mother of famine.
14 Don't let the wages of any man who
works for you wait with you, but give it to
him out of hand. If you serve God, you
will be rewarded. Take heed to yourself,
my child, in all your works, and be
discreet in all your behavior.
15 And what you yourself hate, do to no
man. Don't drink wine to drunkenness,
and don't let drunkenness go with you on
your way.
16 Give of your bread to the hungry, and
of your garments to those who are naked.
Give alms from all your abundance. Don't
let your eye be envious when you give
alms.
17 Pour out your bread on the burial† of
the just, and give nothing to sinners.
18 Ask counsel of every man who is
wise, and don't despise any counsel that is
profitable.
19 Bless the Lord your God at all times,
and ask of him that your ways may be
made straight, and that all your paths and
counsels may prosper; for every nation
has no counsel; but the Lord himself gives
all good things, and he humbles whom he
will, as he will. And now, my child,
remember my commandments, and let
them not be blotted out of your mind.
20 And now I explain to you about the
ten talents of silver, which I left in trust
with Gabael the son of Gabrias at Rages of
Media.
21 And fear not, my child, because we
are made poor. You have much wealth, if
you fear God, and depart from all sin, and
do that which is pleasing in his sight."

5

1 Then Tobias answered and said to him,
"Father, I will do all things, whatever you
have commanded me.
2 But how could I receive the money,
since I don't know him?"
3 He gave him the handwriting, and said
to him, "Seek a man who will go with you,
and I will give him wages, while I still live;
and go and receive the money."
4 He went to seek a man, and found
Raphael who was an angel;
5 and he didn't know it. He said to him,
"Can I go with you to Rages of Media? Do
you know those places well?"
6 The angel said to him, "I will go with
you. I know the way well. I have lodged
with our brother Gabael."
7 Tobias said to him, "Wait for me, and I
will tell my father."
8 He said to him, "Go, and don't wait.
And he went in and said to his father,
"Behold, I have found someone who will
go with me."
But he said, "Call him to me, that I may
know of what tribe he is, and whether he
be a trustworthy man to go with you."
9 So he called him, and he came in, and
they saluted one another.
10 And Tobit said to him, "Brother, of
what tribe and of what family are you?
Tell me."
11 He said to him, "Do you seek a tribe
and a family, or a hired man which will go
with your son?"
And Tobit said to him, "I want to know,
brother, your kindred and your name."
12 And he said, "I am Azarias, the son of
Ananias the great, of your kindred."
13 And he said to him, "Welcome,
brother. Don't be angry with me, because
I sought to know your tribe and family.
You are my brother, of an honest and
good lineage; for I knew Ananias and

† **4:17** Or, *tomb*

Jathan, the sons of Shemaiah the great, when we went together to Jerusalem to worship, and offered the firstborn, and the tenths of our increase; and they didn't go astray in the error of our kindred. My brother, you are of a great stock.
14 But tell me, what wages shall I give you? A drachma a day, and those things that be necessary for you, as to my son?
15 And moreover, if you both return safe and sound, I will add something to your wages."
16 And so they agreed. And he said to Tobias, "Prepare yourself for the journey. May God prosper you." So his son prepared what was needful for the journey, and his father said to him, "Go with this man; but God, who dwells in heaven, will prosper your journey. May his angel go with you."

Then they both departed, and the young man's dog went with them.
17 But Anna his mother wept, and said to Tobit, "Why have you sent away our child? Isn't he the staff of our hand, in going in and out before us?
18 Don't be greedy to add money to money; but let it be as refuse compared to our child.
19 For what the Lord has given us to live is enough for us."
20 Tobit said to her, "Don't worry, my sister. He will return safe and sound, and your eyes will see him.
21 For a good angel will go with him. His journey will be prospered, and he will return safe and sound."
22 So she stopped weeping.

6

1 Now as they went on their journey, they came at evening to the river Tigris, and they lodged there.
2 But the young man went down to wash himself, and a fish leaped out of the river, and would have swallowed up the young man.
3 But the angel said to him, "Grab the fish!"

So the young man grabbed the fish, and hauled it up onto the land.
4 And the angel said to him, "Cut the fish open, and take the heart, the liver, and the bile, and keep them with you."
5 And the young man did as the angel commanded him; but they roasted the fish, and ate it. And they both went on their way, till they drew near to Ecbatana.
6 The young man said to the angel, "Brother Azarias, of what use is the heart, the liver, and the bile of the fish?"
7 He said to him, "About the heart and the liver: If a demon or an evil spirit troubles anyone, we must burn those and make smoke of them before the man or the woman, and the affliction will flee.
8 But as for the bile, it is good to anoint a man that has white films in his eyes, and he will be healed."
9 But when they drew near to Rages,
10 the angel said to the young man, "Brother, today we will lodge with Raguel. He is your kinsman. He has an only daughter named Sarah. I will speak about her, that she should be given to you for a wife.
11 For her inheritance belongs to you, and you only are of her kindred.
12 The maid is fair and wise. And now hear me, and I will speak to her father. When we return from Rages we will celebrate the marriage; for I know that Raguel may in no way marry her to another according to the law of Moses, or else he would be liable to death, because it belongs to you to take the inheritance, rather than any other."
13 Then the young man said to the angel, "Brother Azarias, I have heard that this maid has been given to seven men, and that they all perished in the bride-chamber.
14 Now I am the only son of my father, and I am afraid, lest I go in and die, even as those before me. For a demon loves her, which harms no man, but those which come to her. Now I fear lest I die, and bring my father's and my mother's life to the grave with sorrow because of me. They have no other son to bury them."
15 But the angel said to him, "Don't you remember the words which your father commanded you, that you should take a

wife of your own kindred? Now hear me, brother; for she will be your wife. Don't worry about the demon; for this night she will be given you as wife.
16 And when† you come into the bride-chamber, you shall take the ashes of incense, and shall lay upon them some of the heart and liver of the fish, and shall make smoke with them.
17 The demon will smell it, and flee away, and never come again any more. But when you go near to her, both of you rise up, and cry to God who is merciful. He will save you, and have mercy on you. Don't be afraid, for she was prepared for you from the beginning; and you will save her, and she will go with you. And I suppose that you will have children with her."
When Tobias heard these things, he loved her, and his soul was strongly joined to her.

7

1 They came to Ecbatana, and arrived at the house of Raguel. But Sarah met them; and she greeted them, and they her. Then she brought them into the house.
2 Raguel said to Edna his wife, "This young man really resembles Tobit my cousin!"
3 And Raguel asked them, "Where are you two from, kindred?"
They said to him, "We are of the sons of Naphtali, who are captives in Nineveh."
4 He said to them, "Do you know Tobit our brother?"
They said, "We know him."
Then he said to them, "Is he in good health?"
5 They said, "He is both alive, and in good health." Tobias said, "He is my father."
6 And Raguel sprang up, and kissed him, wept,
7 blessed him, and said to him, "You are the son of an honest and good man." When he had heard that Tobit had lost his sight, he was grieved, and wept;
8 and Edna his wife and Sarah his daughter wept. They received them gladly; and they killed a ram of the flock, and served them meat.
But Tobias said to Raphael, "Brother Azarias, speak of those things of which you talked about in the way, and let the matter be finished."
9 So he communicated the thing to Raguel. Raguel said to Tobias, "Eat, drink, and make merry:
10 for it belongs to you to take my child. However I will tell you the truth.
11 I have given my child to seven men of our relatives, and whenever they came in to her, they died in the night. But for the present be merry."
And Tobias said, "I will taste nothing here, until you all make a covenant and enter into that covenant with me."
12 Raguel said, "Take her to yourself from now on according to custom. You are her relative, and she is yours. The merciful God will give all good success to you."
13 And he called his daughter Sarah, and took her by the hand, and gave her to be wife of Tobias, and said, "Behold, take her to yourself after the law of Moses, and lead her away to your father." And he blessed them.
14 He called Edna his wife, then took a book, wrote a contract, and sealed it.
15 Then they began to eat.
16 And Raguel called his wife Edna, and said to her, "Sister, prepare the other chamber, and bring her in there."
17 She did as he asked her, and brought her in there. She wept, and she received the tears of her daughter, and said to her,
18 "Be comforted, my child. May the Lord of heaven and earth give you favor† for this your sorrow. Be comforted, my daughter."

8

1 When they had finished their supper, they brought Tobias in to her.
2 But as he went, he remembered the words of Raphael, and took the ashes of the incense, and put the heart and the

† **6:16** Gr. *if.* † **7:18** Many ancient authorities read *joy.*

liver of the fish on them, and made smoke with them.
3 When the demon smelled that smell, it fled into the uppermost parts of Egypt, and the angel bound him.
4 But after they were both shut in together, Tobias rose up from the bed, and said, “Sister, arise, and let’s pray that the Lord may have mercy on us.”
5 And Tobias began to say, “Blessed are you, O God of our fathers, and blessed is your holy and glorious name forever. Let the heavens bless you, and all your creatures.
6 You made Adam, and gave him Eve his wife for a helper and support. From them came the seed of men. You said, it is not good that the man should be alone. Let’s make him a helper like him.
7 And now, O Lord, I take not this my sister for lust, but in truth. Command that I may find mercy and grow old with her.”
8 She said with him, “Amen.” And they both slept that night.
9 Raguel arose, and went and dug a grave,
10 saying, “Lest he also should die.”
11 And Raguel came into his house,
12 and said to Edna his wife, “Send one of the maidservants, and let them see if he is alive. If not, we will bury him, and no man will know it.”
13 So the maidservant opened the door, and went in, and found them both sleeping,
14 and came out, and told them that he was alive.
15 Then Raguel blessed God, saying, “Blessed are you, O God, with all pure and holy blessing! Let your saints bless you, and all your creatures! Let all your angels and your elect bless you forever!
16 Blessed are you, because you have made me glad; and it has not happened to me as I suspected; but you have dealt with us according to your great mercy.
17 Blessed are you, because you have had mercy on two that were the only begotten children of their parents. Show them mercy, O Lord. Fulfill their life in health with gladness and mercy.
18 He commanded his servants to fill the grave.
19 He kept the wedding feast for them fourteen days.
20 Before the days of the wedding feast were finished, Raguel sware to him, that he should not depart till the fourteen days of the wedding feast were fulfilled;
21 and that then he should take half of his goods, and go in safety to his father; and the rest, said he, when my wife and I die.

9

1 And Tobias called Raphael, and said to him,
2 “Brother Azarias, take with you a servant and two camels, and go to Rages of Media to Gabael, and receive the money for me, and bring him to the wedding feast,
3 because Raguel has sworn that I must not depart.
4 My father counts the days; and if I wait long, he will be very grieved.
5 So Raphael went on his way, and lodged with Gabael, and gave him the handwriting; so he brought forth the bags with their seals, and gave them to him.
6 Then they rose up early in the morning together, and came to the wedding feast. Tobias blessed his wife.

10

1 Tobit his father counted every day. When the days of the journey were expired, and they didn’t come,
2 he said, “Is he perchance detained?† Or is Gabael perchance dead, and there is no one to give him the money?”
3 He was very grieved.
4 But his wife said to him, “The child has perished, seeing he waits long.” She began to bewail him, and said,
5 “I care about nothing,‡ my child, since I have let you go, the light of my eyes.”
6 Tobit said to her, “Hold your peace. Don’t worry. He is in good health.”

† **10:2** Many ancient authorities read *“Are they perchance put to shame?”* ‡ **10:5** Some authorities read *“Woe is me.”*

7 And she said to him, “Hold your peace. Don’t deceive me. My child has perished.” And she went out every day into the way by which they went, and ate no bread in the day-time, and didn’t stop bewailing her son Tobias for whole nights, until the fourteen days of the wedding feast were expired, which Raguel had sworn that he should spend there.

Then Tobias said to Raguel, “Send me away, for my father and my mother look no more to see me.”
8 But his father-in-law said to him, “Stay with me, and I will send to your father, and they will declare to him how things go with you.”
9 Tobias said, “No. Send me away to my father.”
10 Raguel arose, and gave him Sarah his wife, and half his goods, servants and cattle and money;
11 and he blessed them, and sent them away, saying, “The God of heaven will prosper you, my children, before I die.”
12 And he said to his daughter, “Honor your father-in-law and your mother-in-law. They are now your parents. Let me hear a good report of you.” Then he kissed her.

Edna said to Tobias, “May the Lord of heaven restore you, dear brother, and grant to me that I may see your children of my daughter Sarah, that I may rejoice before the Lord. Behold, I commit my daughter to you in special trust. Don’t cause her grief.

11

1 After these things Tobias also went his way, blessing God because he had prospered his journey; and he blessed Raguel and Edna his wife. Then he went on his way until they drew near to Nineveh.
2 Raphael said to Tobias, “Don’t you know, brother, how you left your father?
3 Let’s run forward before your wife, and prepare the house.
4 But take in your hand the bile of the fish.” So they went their way, and the dog went after them.

5 Anna sat looking around toward the path for her son.
6 She saw him coming, and said to his father, “Behold, your son is coming with the man that went with him!”
7 Raphael said, “I know, Tobias, that your father will open his eyes.
8 Therefore anoint his eyes with the bile, and being pricked with it, he will rub, and will make the white films fall away. Then he will see you.”

9 Anna ran to him, and fell upon the neck of her son, and said to him, “I have seen you, my child! I am ready to die.” They both wept.

10 Tobit went toward the door and stumbled; but his son ran to him,
11 and took hold of his father. He rubbed the bile on his father’s eyes, saying, “Cheer up, my father.”
12 When his eyes began to hurt, he rubbed them.
13 Then the white films peeled away from the corners of his eyes; and he saw his son, and fell upon his neck.

14 He wept, and said, “Blessed are you, O God, and blessed is your name forever! Blessed are all your holy angels!
15 For you scourged, and had mercy on me. Behold, I see my son Tobias.” And his son went in rejoicing, and told his father the great things that had happened to him in Media.
16 Tobit went out to meet his daughter-in-law at the gate of Nineveh, rejoicing and blessing God. Those who saw him go marveled, because he had received his sight.
17 Tobit gave thanks before them, because God had shown mercy on him. When Tobit came near to Sarah his daughter-in-law, he blessed her, saying, “Welcome, daughter! Blessed is God who has brought you to us, and blessed are your father and your mother.” And there was joy among all his kindred who were at Nineveh.
18 Achiacharus and Nasbas his brother’s son came.
19 Tobias’ wedding feast was kept seven days with great gladness.

12

1 And Tobit called his son Tobias, and
said to him, “See, my child, that the man
which went with you have his wages, and
you must give him more.”
2 And he said to him, “Father, it is no
harm to me to give him the half of those
things which I have brought;
3 for he has led me for you in safety, and
he cured my wife, and brought my money,
and likewise cured you.”
4 The old man said, “It is due to him.”
5 And he called the angel, and said to
him, “Take half of all that you have
brought.”
6 Then he called them both privately,
and said to them, “Bless God, and give him
thanks, and magnify him, and give him
thanks in the sight of all that live, for the
things which he has done with you. It is
good to bless God and exalt his name,
showing forth with honor the works of
God. Don’t be slack to give him thanks.
7 It is good to conceal the secret of a
king, but to reveal gloriously the works of
God. Do good, and evil won’t find you.
8 Good is prayer with fasting, alms, and
righteousness. A little with righteousness
is better than much with unrighteousness.
It is better to give alms than to lay up gold.
9 Alms delivers from death, and it
purges away all sin. Those who give alms
and do righteousness will be filled with
life;
10 but those who sin are enemies to their
own life.
11 Surely I will conceal nothing from
you. I have said, ‘It is good to conceal the
secret of a king, but to reveal gloriously
the works of God.’
12 And now, when you prayed, and
Sarah your daughter-in-law, I brought the
memorial of your prayer before the Holy
One. When you buried the dead, I was
with you likewise.
13 And when you didn’t delay to rise up,
and leave your dinner, that you might go
and cover the dead, your good deed was
not hidden from me. I was with you.
14 And now God sent me to heal you and
Sarah your daughter-in-law.
15 I am Raphael, one of the seven holy
angels which present the prayers of the
saints and go in before the glory of the
Holy One.”
16 And they were both troubled, and fell
upon their faces; for they were afraid.
17 And he said to them, “Don’t be afraid.
You will all have peace; but bless God
forever.
18 For I came not of any favor of my
own, but by the will of your God.
Therefore bless him forever.
19 All these days I appeared to you. I
didn’t eat or drink, but you all saw a
vision.
20 Now give God thanks, because I
ascend to him who sent me. Write in a
book all the things which have been
done.”
21 Then they rose up, and saw him no
more.
22 They confessed the great and
wonderful works of God, and how the
angel of the Lord had appeared to them.

13

1 And Tobit wrote a prayer for rejoicing,
and said,
“Blessed is God who lives forever!
Blessed is his kingdom!
2 For he scourges, and shows mercy.
He leads down to the grave,† and
brings up again.
There is no one who will escape his
hand.
3 Give thanks to him before the Gentiles,
all you children of Israel!
For he has scattered us among them.
4 Declare his greatness, there.
Extol him before all the living,
because he is our Lord,
and God is our Father forever.
5 He will scourge us for our iniquities, and
will again show mercy,
and will gather us out of all the
nations among whom you are all
scattered.
6 If you turn to him with your whole heart
and with your whole soul,
to do truth before him,

† **13:2** Gr. *Hades.*

then he will turn to you,
and won't hide his face from you.
See what he will do with you.
Give him thanks with your whole mouth.
Bless the Lord of righteousness.
Exalt the everlasting King.
I give him thanks in the land of my captivity,
and show his strength and majesty to a nation of sinners.
Turn, you sinners, and do righteousness before him.
Who can tell if he will accept you and have mercy on you?
7 I exalt my God.
My soul exalts the King of heaven,
and rejoices in his greatness.
8 Let all men speak,
and let them give him thanks in Jerusalem.
9 O Jerusalem, the holy city,
he will scourge you for the works of your sons,
and will again have mercy on the sons of the righteous.
10 Give thanks to the Lord with goodness,
and bless the everlasting King,
that his tabernacle may be built in you again with joy,
and that he may make glad in you those who are captives,
and love in you forever those who are miserable.
11 Many nations will come from afar to the name of the Lord God
with gifts in their hands, even gifts to the King of heaven.
Generations of generations will praise you,
and sing songs of rejoicing.
12 All those who hate you are cursed.
All those who love you forever will be blessed.
13 Rejoice and be exceedingly glad for the sons of the righteous;
for they will be gathered together and will bless the Lord of the righteous.
14 Oh blessed are those who love you.
They will rejoice for your peace.
Blessed are all those who mourned for all your scourges;
because they will rejoice for you when they have seen all your glory.
They will be made glad forever.
15 Let my soul bless God the great King.
16 For Jerusalem will be built with sapphires, emeralds, and precious stones;
your walls and towers and battlements with pure gold.
17 The streets of Jerusalem will be paved with beryl, carbuncle, and stones of Ophir.
18 All her streets will say, "Hallelujah!"
and give praise, saying, "Blessed be God, who has exalted you forever!"

14

1 Then Tobit finished giving thanks.
2 He was fifty-eight years old when he lost his sight. After eight years, he received it again. He gave alms and he feared the Lord God more and more, and gave thanks to him.
3 Now he grew very old; and he called his son with the six sons of his son, and said to him, "My child, take your sons. Behold, I have grown old, and am ready to depart out of this life.
4 Go into Media, my child, for I surely believe all the things which Jonah the prophet spoke of Nineveh, that it will be overthrown, but in Media there will rather be peace for a season. Our kindred will be scattered in the earth from the good land. Jerusalem will be desolate, and the house of God in it will be burned up, and will be desolate for a time.
5 God will again have mercy on them, and bring them back into the land, and they will build the house, but not like to the former house, until the times of that age are fulfilled. Afterward they will return from the places of their captivity, and build up Jerusalem with honor. The house of God will be built in it forever with a glorious building, even as the prophets spoke concerning it.
6 And all the nations will turn to fear the Lord God truly, and will bury their idols.
7 All the nations will bless the Lord, and his people will give thanks to God, and the

Lord will exalt his people; and all those
who love the Lord God in truth and
righteousness will rejoice, showing mercy
to our kindred.
8 And now, my child, depart from
Nineveh, because those things which the
prophet Jonah spoke will surely come to
pass.
9 But you must keep the law and the
ordinances, and show yourself merciful
and righteous, that it may be well with
you.
10 Bury me decently, and your mother
with me. Don't stay at Nineveh. See, my
child, what Aman did to Achiacharus who
nourished him, how out of light he
brought him into darkness, and all the
recompense that he made him.
Achiacharus was saved, but the other had
his recompense, and he went down into
darkness. Manasses gave alms, and
escaped the snare of death which he set
for him; but Aman fell into the snare, and
perished.
11 And now, my children, consider what
alms does, and how righteousness
delivers."
While he was saying these things, he
gave up the ghost in the bed; but he was
one hundred fifty eight years old. Tobias
buried him magnificently.
12 When Anna died, he buried her with
his father. But Tobias departed with his
wife and his sons to Ecbatana to Raguel
his father-in-law,
13 and he grew old in honor, and he
buried his father-in-law and
mother-in-law magnificently, and he
inherited their possessions, and his father
Tobit's.
14 He died at Ecbatana of Media, being
one hundred twenty seven years old.
15 Before he died, he heard of the
destruction of Nineveh, which
Nebuchadnezzar and Ahasuerus took
captive. Before his death, he rejoiced over
Nineveh.

Judith

Judith is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches.

1 In the twelfth year of the reign of Nebuchadnezzar, who reigned over the Assyrians in Nineveh, the great city, in the days of Arphaxad, who reigned over the Medes in Ecbatana,
2 and built around Ecbatana walls of hewn stones three cubits broad and six cubits long, and made the height of the wall seventy cubits, and its breadth fifty cubits,
3 and set its towers at its gates one hundred cubits high, and its breadth in the foundation was sixty cubits,
4 and made its gates, even gates that were raised to the height of seventy cubits, and their breadth forty cubits, for his mighty army to go out of, and the setting in array of his footmen—
5 in those days King Nebuchadnezzar made war with King Arphaxad in the great plain. This plain is on the borders of Ragau.
6 There came to meet him all that lived in the hill country, and all that lived by Euphrates, Tigris, and Hydaspes, and in the plain of Arioch the king of the Elymaeans. Many nations of the sons of Chelod assembled themselves to the battle.
7 And Nebuchadnezzar king of the Assyrians sent to all who lived in Persia, and to all who lived westward, to those who lived in Cilicia, Damascus, Libanus, Antilibanus, and to all who lived along the sea coast,
8 and to those among the nations that were of Carmel and Gilead, and to the higher Galilee and the great plain of Esdraelon,
9 and to all who were in Samaria and its cities, and beyond Jordan to Jerusalem, Betane, Chellus, Kadesh, the river of Egypt, Tahpanhes, Rameses, and all the land of Goshen,
10 until you come above Tanis and Memphis, and to all that lived in Egypt, until you come to the borders of Ethiopia.
11 All those who lived in all the land made light of the commandment of Nebuchadnezzar king of the Assyrians, and didn't go with him to the war; for they were not afraid of him, but he was before them as one man. They turned away his messengers from their presence without effect, and with disgrace.
12 And Nebuchadnezzar was exceedingly angry with all this land, and he swore by his throne and kingdom that he would surely be avenged upon all the coasts of Cilicia, Damascus, and Syria, that he would kill with his sword all the inhabitants of the land of Moab, the children of Ammon, all Judea, and all who were in Egypt, until you come to the borders of the two seas.
13 And he set the battle in array with his army against King Arphaxad in the seventeenth year; and he prevailed in his battle, and turned to flight all the army of Arphaxad, with all his horses and all his chariots.
14 He took possession of his cities. He came to Ecbatana and took the towers, plundered its streets, and turned its beauty into shame.
15 He took Arphaxad in the mountains of Ragau, struck him through with his darts, and utterly destroyed him to this day.
16 He returned with them to Nineveh, he and all his company of sundry nations—an exceedingly great multitude of men of war. There he took his ease and banqueted, he and his army, for one hundred twenty days.

2

1 In the eighteenth year, the twenty-second day of the first month, there was talk in the house of Nebuchadnezzar king of the Assyrians that he should be avenged on all the land, even as he spoke.
2 He called together all his servants and all his great men, and communicated with them his secret counsel, and with his own

mouth, recounted the wickedness of all the land.
3 They decreed to destroy all flesh which didn't follow the word of his mouth.
4 It came to pass, when he had ended his counsel, Nebuchadnezzar king of the Assyrians called Holofernes the chief captain of his army, who was second to himself, and said to him,
5 "The great king, the lord of all the earth, says: 'Behold, you shall go out from my presence, and take with you men who trust in their strength, to one hundred twenty thousand footmen and twelve thousand horses with their riders.
6 And you shall go out against all the west country, because they disobeyed the commandment of my mouth.
7 You shall declare to them that they should prepare earth and water, because I will go out in my wrath against them, and will cover the whole face of the earth with the feet of my army, who will plunder them.
8 Their slain will fill their valleys and brooks, and the river will be filled with their dead until it overflows.
9 I will lead them as captives to the utmost parts of all the earth.
10 But you shall go forth, and take all their coasts for me first. If they will yield themselves to you,† then you must reserve them for me until the day of their reproof.
11 As for those who resist, your eye shall not spare; but you shall give them up to be slain and to be plundered in all your land.
12 For as I live, and by the power of my kingdom, I have spoken, and I will do this with my hand.
13 Moreover, you shall not transgress anything of the commandments of your lord, but you shall surely accomplish them, as I have commanded you. You shall not defer to do them.' "
14 So Holofernes went out from the presence of his lord, and called all the governors, the captains, and officers of the army of Asshur.
15 He counted chosen men for the battle, as his lord had commanded him, to one hundred twenty thousand, with twelve thousand archers on horseback.
16 He arranged them as a great multitude is ordered for the war.
17 He took camels, donkeys, and mules for their baggage, an exceedingly great multitude, and sheep, oxen, and goats without number for their provision,
18 and a large supply of rations for every man, and a huge amount of gold and silver out of the king's house.
19 He went out, he and all his army, on their journey, to go before King Nebuchadnezzar, and to cover all the face of the earth westward with their chariots, horsemen, and chosen footmen.
20 A great company of various nations went out with them like locusts and like the sand of the earth. For they could not be counted by reason of their multitude.
21 And they departed out of Nineveh three days' journey toward the plain of Bectileth, and encamped from Bectileth near the mountain which is at the left hand of the Upper Cilicia.
22 And he took all his army, his footmen, horsemen, and chariots, and went away from there into the hill country,
23 and destroyed Put and Lud, and plundered all the children of Rasses and the children of Ishmael, which were along the wilderness to the south of the land of the Chellians.
24 And he went over Euphrates, and went through Mesopotamia, and broke down all the high cities that were upon the river Arbonai, until you come to the sea.
25 And he took possession of the borders of Cilicia, and killed all who resisted him, and came to the borders of Japheth, which were toward the south, opposite Arabia.
26 He surrounded all the children of Midian, and set their tents on fire, and plundered their sheepfolds.
27 He went down into the plain of Damascus in the days of wheat harvest, and set all their fields on fire, and utterly destroyed their flocks and herds, plundered their cities, laid their plains waste, and struck all their young men

† **2:10** Gr. *they will yield...and you shall reserve.*

with the edge of the sword.
28 And the fear and the dread of him fell upon those who lived on the sea coast, upon those who were in Sidon and Tyre, those who lived in Sur and Ocina, and all who lived in Jemnaan. Those who lived in Azotus and Ascalon feared him exceedingly.

3

1 And they sent to him messengers with words of peace, saying,
2 "Behold, we the servants of Nebuchadnezzar the great king lie before you. Use us as it is pleasing in your sight.
3 Behold, our dwellings, and all our country, and all our fields of wheat, and our flocks and herds, and all the sheepfolds of our tents, lie before your face. Use them as it may please you.
4 Behold, even our cities and those who dwell in them are your servants. Come and deal with them as it is good in your eyes."
5 So the men came to Holofernes, and declared to him according to these words.
6 He came down toward the sea coast, he and his army, and set garrisons in the high cities, and took out of them chosen men for allies.
7 They received him, they and all the country round about them, with garlands and dances and timbrels.
8 He cast down all their borders, and cut down their sacred groves. It had been given to him to destroy all the gods of the land, that all the nations would worship Nebuchadnezzar only, and that all their tongues and their tribes would call upon him as a god.
9 Then he came toward Esdraelon near to Dotaea, which is opposite the great ridge of Judea.
10 He encamped between Geba and Scythopolis. He was there a whole month, that he might gather together all the baggage of his army.

4

1 The children of Israel who lived in Judea heard all that Holofernes the chief captain of Nebuchadnezzar king of the Assyrians had done to the nations, and how he had plundered all their temples and destroyed them utterly.
2 They were exceedingly afraid at his approach, and were troubled for Jerusalem and for the temple of the Lord their God;
3 because they had newly come up from the captivity, and all the people of Judea were recently gathered together; and the vessels, the altar, and the house were sanctified after being profaned.
4 And they sent into every coast of Samaria, to Konae, to Beth-horon, Belmaim, Jericho, to Choba, Aesora, and to the valley of Salem;
5 and they occupied beforehand all the tops of the high mountains, fortified the villages that were in them, and stored supplies for the provision of war, for their fields were newly reaped.
6 Joakim the high priest, who was in those days at Jerusalem, wrote to those who lived in Bethulia and Betomesthaim, which is opposite Esdraelon toward the plain that is near to Dothaim,
7 charging them to seize upon the ascents of the hill country; because by them was the entrance into Judea, and it was easy to stop them from approaching, inasmuch as the approach was narrow, with space for two men at the most.
8 And the children of Israel did as Joakim the high priest had commanded them, as did the senate of all the people of Israel, which was in session at Jerusalem.
9 And every man of Israel cried to God with great earnestness, and with great earnestness they humbled their souls.
10 They, their wives, their children, their cattle, and every sojourner, hireling, and servant bought with their money put sackcloth on their loins.
11 Every man and woman of Israel, including the little children and the inhabitants of Jerusalem, fell prostrate before the temple, cast ashes upon their heads, and spread out their sackcloth before the Lord. They put sackcloth around the altar.

12 They cried to the God of Israel
earnestly with one consent, that he would
not give their children as prey, their wives
as plunder, the cities of their inheritance
to destruction, and the sanctuary to being
profaned and being made a reproach, for
the nations to rejoice at.
13 The Lord heard their voice, and
looked at their affliction. The people
continued fasting many days in all Judea
and Jerusalem before the sanctuary of the
Lord Almighty.
14 And Joakim the high priest, and all
the priests who stood before the Lord, and
those who ministered to the Lord, had
their loins dressed in sackcloth and
offered the continual burnt offering, the
vows, and the free gifts of the people.
15 They had ashes on their turbans.
They cried to the Lord with all their
power, that he would look upon all the
house of Israel for good.

5

1 Holofernes, the chief captain of the
army of Asshur, was told that the children
of Israel had prepared for war, had shut
up the passages of the hill country, had
fortified all the tops of the high hills, and
had set up barricades in the plains.
2 Then he was exceedingly angry, and
he called all the princes of Moab, the
captains of Ammon, and all the governors
of the sea coast,
3 and he said to them, “Tell me now, you
sons of Canaan, who are these people who
dwell in the hill country? What are the
cities that they inhabit? How large is their
army? Where is their power and their
strength? What king is set over them, to
be the leader of their army?
4 Why have they turned their backs,
that they should not come and meet me,
more than all who dwell in the west?”
5 Then Achior, the leader of all the
children of Ammon, said to him, “Let my
lord now hear a word from the mouth of
your servant, and I will tell you the truth
concerning these people who dwell in this
hill country, near to the place where you
dwell. No lie will come out of the mouth of
your servant.
6 These people are descended from the
Chaldeans.
7 They sojourned before this in
Mesopotamia, because they didn’t want to
follow the gods of their fathers, which
were in the land of the Chaldeans.
8 They departed from the way of their
parents, and worshiped the God of
heaven, the God whom they knew. Their
parents cast them out from the face of
their gods, and they fled into
Mesopotamia and sojourned there many
days.
9 Then their God commanded them to
depart from the place where they
sojourned, and to go into the land of
Canaan. They lived there, and prospered
with gold and silver, and with exceedingly
much cattle.
10 Then they went down into Egypt, for
a famine covered all the land of Canaan.
They sojourned there until they had
grown up. They became a great multitude
there, so that one could not count the
population of their nation.
11 Then the king of Egypt rose up against
them, and dealt subtly with them, and
brought them low, making them labor in
brick,† and made them slaves.
12 They cried to their God, and he struck
all the land of Egypt with incurable
plagues; so the Egyptians cast them out of
their sight.
13 God dried up the Red sea before them,
14 and brought them into the way of
Sinai Kadesh-Barnea and they cast out all
that lived in the wilderness.
15 They lived in the land of the Amorites,
and they destroyed by their strength
everyone in Heshbon. Passing over
Jordan, they possessed all the hill country.
16 They cast out before them the
Canaanite, the Perizzite, the Jebusite, the
Shechemite, and all the Girgashites, and
they lived in that country many days.
17 And while they didn’t sin before their
God, they prospered, because God who
hates iniquity was with them.

† **5:11** Some authorities read *and he brought them low with clay and brick, etc.*

18 But when they departed from the way
which he appointed them, they were
destroyed in many severe battles, and
were led captives into a land that was not
theirs. The temple of their God was razed
to the ground, and their cities were taken
by their adversaries.
19 And now they have returned to their
God, and have come up from the
dispersion where they were dispersed,
and have possessed Jerusalem, where
their sanctuary is, and are settled in the
hill country; for it was desolate.
20 And now, my lord and master, if there
is any error in this people, and they sin
against their God, we will find out what
this thing is in which they stumble, and
we will go up and overcome them.
21 But if there is no lawlessness in their
nation, let my lord now pass by, lest their
Lord defend them, and their God be for
them, and we will be a reproach before all
the earth."
22 It came to pass, when Achior had
finished speaking these words, all the
people standing around the tent
complained. The great men of Holofernes,
and all who lived by the sea side and in
Moab, said that he should be cut to pieces.
23 For, they said, "We will not be afraid
of the children of Israel, because, behold,
they are a people that has no power nor
might to make the battle strong.
24 Therefore now we will go up, and
they will be a prey to be devoured by all
your army, Lord Holofernes."

6

1 And when the disturbance of the men
that were around the council had ceased,
Holofernes the chief captain of the army
of Asshur said to Achior and to all the
children of Moab† before all the people of
the foreigners:
2 "And who are you, Achior, and the
mercenaries of Ephraim,‡ that you have
prophesied among us as today, and have
said that we should not make war with
the race of Israel, because their God will
defend them? And who is God but
Nebuchadnezzar?
3 He will send forth his might, and will
destroy them from the face of the earth,
and their God will not deliver them; but
we his servants will strike them as one
man. They will not sustain the might of
our cavalry.
4 For with them we will burn them up.
Their mountains will be drunken with
their blood. Their plains will be filled with
their dead bodies. Their footsteps will not
stand before us, but they will surely
perish, says King Nebuchadnezzar, lord of
all the earth; for he said, 'The words that I
have spoken§ will not be in vain.'
5 But you, Achior, hireling of Ammon,
who have spoken these words in the day
of your iniquity, will see my face no more
from this day, until I am avenged of the
race of those that came out of Egypt.
6 And then the sword of my army, and
the multitude of those who serve me, will
pass through your sides, and you will fall
among their slain when I return.
7 Then my servants will bring you back
into the hill country, and will set you in
one of the cities by the passes.
8 You will not perish until you are
destroyed with them.
9 And if you hope in your heart that they
will not be taken, don't let your
countenance fall. I have spoken it, and
none of my words will fall to the ground."
10 Then Holofernes commanded his
servants who waited in his tent to take
Achior, and bring him back to Bethulia,
and deliver him into the hands of the
children of Israel.
11 So his servants took him, and brought
him out of the camp into the plain, and
they moved from the midst of the plains
into the hill country, and came to the
springs that were under Bethulia.
12 When the men of the city saw them
on the top of the hill, they took up their
weapons, and went out of the city against
them to the top of the hill. Every man that
used a sling kept them from coming up,
and threw stones at them.

† **6:1** Some authorities read *Ammon.* Compare ver. 5.
‡ **6:2** Some authorities read *Ammon.* Compare ver. 5.
§ **6:4** Gr. *he has spoken.*

13 They took cover under the hill, bound
Achior, cast him down, left him at the foot
of the hill, and went away to their lord.
14 But the children of Israel descended
from their city, and came to him, untied
him, led him away into Bethulia, and
presented him to the rulers of their city,
15 which were in those days Ozias the
son of Micah, of the tribe of Simeon, and
Chabris the son of Gothoniel, and Charmis
the son of Melchiel.
16 Then they called together all the
elders of the city; and all their young men
ran together, with their women, to the
assembly. They set Achior in the midst of
all their people. Then Ozias asked him
what had happened.
17 He answered and declared to them
the words of the council of Holofernes,
and all the words that he had spoken in
the midst of the princes of the children of
Asshur, and all the great words that
Holofernes had spoken against the house
of Israel.
18 Then the people fell down and
worshiped God, and cried, saying,
19 "O Lord God of heaven, behold their
arrogance, and pity the low estate of our
race. Look upon the face of those who are
sanctified to you this day."
20 They comforted Achior, and praised
him exceedingly.
21 Then Ozias took him out of the
assembly into his house, and made a feast
for the elders. They called on the God of
Israel for help all that night.

7

1 The next day Holofernes commanded
all his army and all the people who had
come to be his allies, that they should
move their camp toward Bethulia, seize
the passes of the hill country, and make
war against the children of Israel.
2 Every mighty man of them moved that
day. The army of their men of war was
one hundred seventy thousand footmen,
plus twelve thousand horsemen, besides
the baggage and the men who were on
foot among them—an exceedingly great
multitude.
3 They encamped in the valley near
Bethulia, by the fountain. They spread
themselves in breadth over Dothaim even
to Belmaim, and in length from Bethulia
to Cyamon, which is near Esdraelon.
4 But the children of Israel, when they
saw the multitude of them, were terrified,
and everyone said to his neighbor, "Now
these men will lick up the face of all the
earth. Neither the high mountains, nor
the valleys, nor the hills will be able to
bear their weight.
5 Every man took up his weapons of
war, and when they had kindled fires
upon their towers, they remained and
watched all that night.
6 But on the second day Holofernes led
out all his cavalry in the sight of the
children of Israel which were in Bethulia,
7 viewed the ascents to their city, and
searched out the springs of the waters,
seized upon them, and set garrisons of
men of war over them. Then he departed
back to his people.
8 All the rulers of the children of Esau,
all the leaders of the people of Moab, and
the captains of the sea coast came to him
and said,
9 "Let our lord now hear a word, that
there not be losses in your army.
10 For this people of the children of
Israel do not trust in their spears, but in
the height of the mountains wherein they
dwell, for it is not easy to come up to the
tops of their mountains.
11 And now, my lord, don't fight against
them as men fight who join battle, and
there will not so much as one man of your
people perish.
12 Remain in your camp, and keep every
man of your army safe. Let your servants
get possession of the water spring, which
flows from the foot of the mountain,
13 because all the inhabitants of
Bethulia get their water from there. Then
thirst will kill them, and they will give up
their city. Then we and our people will go
up to the tops of the mountains that are
near, and will camp upon them, to watch
that not one man gets out of the city.

14 They will be consumed with
famine—they, their wives, and their
children. Before the sword comes against
them they will be laid low in the streets
where they dwell.
15 And you will pay them back with evil,
because they rebelled, and didn't meet
your face in peace."
16 Their words were pleasing in the
sight of Holofernes and in the sight of all
his servants; and he ordered them to do as
they had spoken.
17 And the army of the children of
Ammon moved, and with them five
thousand of the children of Asshur, and
they encamped in the valley. They seized
the waters and the springs of the waters
of the children of Israel.
18 The children of Esau went up with the
children of Ammon, and encamped in the
hill country near Dothaim. They sent
some of them toward the south, and
toward the east, near Ekrebel, which is
near Chusi, that is upon the brook
Mochmur. The rest of the army of the
Assyrians encamped in the plain, and
covered all the face of the land. Their
tents and baggage were pitched upon it in
a great crowd. They were an exceedingly
great multitude.
19 The children of Israel cried to the
Lord their God, for their spirit fainted; for
all their enemies had surrounded them.
There was no way to escape out from
among them.
20 All the army of Asshur remained
around them, their footmen and their
chariots and their horsemen, for
thirty-four days. All their vessels of water
ran dry for all the inhabitants of Bethulia.
21 The cisterns were emptied, and they
had no water to drink their fill for one
day; for they rationed drink by measure.
22 Their young children were
discouraged. The women and the young
men fainted for thirst. They fell down in
the streets of the city, and in the passages
of the gates. There was no longer any
strength in them.
23 All the people, including the young
men, the women, and the children, were
gathered together against Ozias, and
against the rulers of the city. They cried
with a loud voice, and said before all the
elders,
24 "God be judge between all of you and
us, because you have done us great
wrong, in that you have not spoken words
of peace with the children of Asshur.
25 Now we have no helper; but God has
sold us into their hands, that we should be
laid low before them with thirst and great
destruction.
26 And now summon them, and deliver
up the whole city as prey to the people of
Holofernes, and to all his army.
27 For it is better for us to be captured by
them. For we will be servants, and our
souls will live, and we will not see the
death of our babies before our eyes, and
our wives and our children fainting in
death.
28 We take to witness against you the sky
and the earth, and our God and the Lord
of our fathers, who punishes us according
to our sins and the sins of our fathers. Do
what we have said today!"
29 And there was great weeping of all
with one consent in the midst of the
assembly; and they cried to the Lord God
with a loud voice.
30 And Ozias said to them, "Brethren, be
of good courage! Let us endure five more
days, during which the Lord our God will
turn his mercy toward us; for he will not
forsake us utterly.
31 But if these days pass, and no help
comes to us, I will do what you say."
32 Then he dispersed the people, every
man to his own camp; and they went
away to the walls and towers of their city.
He sent the women and children into
their houses. They were brought very low
in the city.

8

1 In those days Judith heard about this.
She was the daughter of Merari, the son of
Ox, the son of Joseph, the son of Oziel, the
son of Elkiah, the son of Ananias, the son
of Gideon, the son of Raphaim, the son of
Ahitub, the son of Elihu, the son of Eliab,
the son of Nathanael, the son of Salamiel,
the son of Salasadai, the son of Israel.

2 Her husband was Manasses, of her
tribe and of her family. He died in the
days of barley harvest.
3 For he stood over those who bound
sheaves in the field, and was overcome by
the burning heat, and he fell on his bed,
and died in his city Bethulia. So they
buried him with his fathers in the field
which is between Dothaim and Balamon.
4 Judith was a widow in her house three
years and four months.
5 She made herself a tent upon the roof
of her house, and put on sackcloth upon
her loins. The garments of her
widowhood were upon her.
6 And she fasted all the days of her
widowhood, except the eves of the
Sabbaths, the Sabbaths, the eves of the
new moons, the new moons, and the
feasts and joyful days of the house of
Israel.
7 She was beautiful in appearance, and
lovely to behold. Her husband Manasses
had left her gold, silver, menservants,
maidservants, cattle, and lands. She
remained on those lands.
8 No one said anything evil about her,
for she feared God exceedingly.

9 She heard the evil words of the people
against the governor, because they
fainted for lack of water; and Judith heard
all the words that Ozias spoke to them,
how he swore to them that he would
deliver the city to the Assyrians after five
days.
10 So she sent her maid, who was over
all things that she had, to summon Ozias,
Chabris, and Charmis, the elders of her
city.
11 They came to her, and she said to
them, “Hear me now, O you rulers of the
inhabitants of Bethulia! For your word
that you have spoken before the people
this day is not right. You have set the oath
which you have pronounced between God
and you, and have promised to deliver the
city to our enemies, unless within these
days the Lord turns to help you.
12 Now who are you that you have
tested God this day, and stand in the place
of God among the children of men?
13 Now try the Lord Almighty, and you
will never know anything.
14 For you will not find the depth of the
heart of man, and you will not perceive
the things that he thinks. How will you
search out God, who has made all these
things, and know his mind, and
comprehend his purpose? No, my
kindred, don’t provoke the Lord our God
to anger!
15 For if he has not decided to help us
within these five days, he has power to
defend us in such time as he will, or to
destroy us before the face of our enemies.
16 But don’t you pledge the counsels of
the Lord our God! For God is not like a
human being, that he should be
threatened, neither is he like a son of man,
that he should be won over by pleading.
17 Therefore let’s wait for the salvation
that comes from him, and call upon him
to help us. He will hear our voice, if it
pleases him.
18 For there arose none in our age,
neither is there any of us today, tribe, or
kindred, or family, or city, which worship
gods made with hands, as it was in the
former days;
19 for which cause our fathers were
given to the sword, and for plunder, and
fell with a great destruction before our
enemies.
20 But we know no other god beside
him. Therefore we hope that he will not
despise us, nor any of our race.
21 For if we are captured, all Judea will
be captured and our sanctuary will be
plundered; and he will require our blood
for profaning it.
22 The slaughter of our kindred, the
captivity of the land, and the desolation of
our inheritance, he will bring on our
heads among the Gentiles, wherever we
will be in bondage. We will be an offense
and a reproach to those who take us for a
possession.
23 For our bondage will not be ordered
to favor; but the Lord our God will turn it
to dishonor.
24 And now, kindred, let’s show an
example to our kindred, because their

soul depends on us, and the sanctuary, the house, and the altar depend on us.
25 Besides all this let's give thanks to the Lord our God, who tries us, even as he did our fathers also.
26 Remember all the things which he did to Abraham, and all the things in which he tried Isaac, and all the things which happened to Jacob in Mesopotamia of Syria, when he kept the sheep of Laban his mother's brother.
27 For he has not tried us in the fire, as he did them, to search out their hearts, neither has he taken vengeance on us; but the Lord scourges those who come near to him, to admonish them."
28 And Ozias said to her, "All that you have spoken, you have spoken with a good heart. There is no one who will deny your words.
29 For this is not the first day wherein your wisdom is manifested; but from the beginning of your days all the people have known your understanding, because the disposition of your heart is good.
30 But the people were exceedingly thirsty, and compelled us to do as we spoke to them, and to bring an oath upon ourselves, which we will not break.
31 And now pray for us, because you are a godly woman, and the Lord will send us rain to fill our cisterns, and we will faint no more."
32 Then Judith said to them, "Hear me, and I will do a thing, which will go down to all generations among the children of our race.
33 You shall all stand at the gate tonight. I will go out with my maid. Within the days after which you said that you would deliver the city to our enemies, the Lord will deliver Israel by my hand.
34 But you shall not inquire of my act; for I will not tell you until the things are finished that I will do."
35 Then Ozias and the rulers said to her, "Go in peace. May the Lord God be before you, to take vengeance on our enemies."
36 So they returned from the tent, and went to their stations.

9

1 But Judith fell upon her face, and put ashes upon her head, and uncovered the sackcloth with which she was clothed. The incense of that evening was now being offered at Jerusalem in the house of God, and Judith cried to the Lord with a loud voice, and said,
2 "O Lord God of my father Simeon, into whose hand you gave a sword to take vengeance on the strangers who loosened the belt of a virgin to defile her, uncovered her thigh to her shame, and profaned her womb to her reproach; for you said, 'It shall not be so;' and they did so.
3 Therefore you gave their rulers to be slain, and their bed, which was ashamed for her who was deceived,† to be dyed in blood, and struck the servants with their masters, and the masters upon their thrones;
4 and gave their wives for a prey, and their daughters to be captives, and all their spoils to be divided among your dear children; which were moved with zeal for you, and abhorred the pollution of their blood, and called upon you for aid. O God, O my God, hear me also who am a widow.
5 For you did the things that were before those things, and those things, and such as come after; and you planned the things which are now, and the things which are to come. The things which you planned came to pass.
6 Yes, the things which you determined stood before you, and said, 'Behold, we are here; for all your ways are prepared, and your judgment is with foreknowledge.'
7 For, behold, the Assyrians are multiplied in their power. They are exalted with horse and rider. They were proud of the strength of their footmen. They have trusted in shield, spear, bow, and sling. They don't know that you are the Lord who breaks the battles. 'The Lord' is your name.
8 Break their strength in your power, and bring down their force in your wrath; for they intend to profane your sanctuary, and to defile the tabernacle where your

† **9:3** Some authorities read *which was ashamed for their deceit that they practiced.*

glorious name rests, and to destroy the horn of your altar with the sword.
9 Look at their pride, and send your wrath upon their heads. Give into my hand, which am a widow, the might that I have conceived.
10 Strike by the deceit of my lips the servant with the prince, and the prince with his servant. Break down their arrogance by the hand of a woman.
11 For your power stands not in numbers, nor your might in strong men, but you are a God of the afflicted. You are a helper of the oppressed, a helper of the weak, a protector of the forsaken, a savior of those who are without hope.
12 Please, please, God of my father, and God of the inheritance of Israel, Lord of the heavens and of the earth, Creator of the waters, King of all your creation, hear my prayer.
13 Make my speech and deceit to be their wound and bruise, who intend hard things against your covenant, your holy house, the top of Zion, and the house of the possession of your children.
14 Make every nation and tribe of yours to know that you are God, the God of all power and might, and that there is no other who protects the race of Israel but you."

10

1 It came to pass, when she had ceased to cry to the God of Israel, and had finished saying all these words,
2 that she rose up where she had fallen down, called her maid, and went down into the house that she lived on the Sabbath days and on her feast days.
3 She pulled off the sackcloth which she had put on, took off the garments of her widowhood, washed her body all over with water, anointed herself with rich ointment, braided the hair of her head, and put a tiara upon it. She put on her garments of gladness, which she used to wear in the days of the life of Manasses her husband.
4 She took sandals for her feet, and put on her anklet, bracelets, rings, earrings, and all her jewelry. She made herself very beautiful to deceive the eyes of all men who would see her.
5 She gave her maid a leather container of wine and a flask of oil, and filled a bag with roasted grain, lumps of figs, and fine bread. She packed all her vessels together, and laid them upon her.
6 They went out to the gate of the city of Bethulia, and found Ozias and the elders of the city, Chabris and Charmis standing by it.
7 But when they saw her, that her countenance was altered and her apparel was changed, they were greatly astonished by her beauty and said to her,
8 "May the God of our fathers give you favor, and accomplish your purposes to the glory of the children of Israel, and to the exaltation of Jerusalem."

Then she worshiped God,
9 and said to them, "Command that they open the gate of the city for me, and I will go out to accomplish the things you spoke with me about."

And they commanded the young men to open to her, as she had spoken;
10 and they did so.

Then Judith went out, she, and her handmaid with her. The men of the city watched her until she had gone down the mountain, until she had passed the valley, and they could see her no more.
11 They went straight onward in the valley. The watch of the Assyrians met her;
12 and they took her, and asked her, "Of what people are you? Where are you coming from? Where are you going?"

She said, "I am a daughter of the Hebrews. I am fleeing away from their presence, because they are about to be given you to be consumed.
13 I am coming into the presence of Holofernes the chief captain of your army, to declare words of truth. I will show him a way that he can go and win all the hill country, and there will not be lacking of his men one person, nor one life."
14 Now when the men heard her words, and considered her countenance, the

beauty thereof was exceedingly
marvelous in their eyes. They said to her,
15 “You have saved your life, in that you
have hurried to come down to the
presence of our master. Now come to his
tent. Some of us will guide you until they
deliver you into his hands.
16 But when† you stand before him,
don’t be afraid in your heart, but declare
to him what you just said, and he will
treat you well.”
17 They chose out of them a hundred
men, and appointed them to accompany
her and her maid; and they brought them
to the tent of Holofernes.
18 And there was great excitement
throughout all the camp, for her coming
was reported among the tents. They came
and surrounded her as she stood outside
Holofernes’ tent, until they told him about
her.
19 They marveled at her beauty, and
marveled at the children of Israel because
of her. Each one said to his neighbor,
“Who would despise these people, who
have among them such women? For it is
not good that one man of them be left,
seeing that, if they are let go, they will be
able to deceive the whole earth.
20 Then the guards of Holofernes and all
his servants came out and brought her
into the tent.
21 And Holofernes was resting upon his
bed under the canopy, which was woven
with purple, gold, emeralds, and precious
stones.
22 And they told him about her; and he
came out into the space before his tent,
with silver lamps going before him.
23 But when Judith had come before him
and his servants, they all marveled at the
beauty of her countenance. She fell down
upon her face and bowed down to him,
but his servants raised her up.

11

1 Holofernes said to her, “Woman, take
courage. Don’t be afraid in your heart; for
I never hurt anyone who has chosen to
serve Nebuchadnezzar, the king of all the
earth.
2 And now, if your people who dwell in
the hill country had not slighted me, I
would not have lifted up my spear against
them; but they have done these things to
themselves.
3 And now tell me why you fled from
them and came to us; for you have come
to save yourself. Take courage! You will
live tonight, and hereafter;
4 for there is no one that will wrong you,
but all will treat you well, as is done to the
servants of King Nebuchadnezzar my
lord.”
5 And Judith said to him, “Receive the
words of your servant, and let your
handmaid speak in your presence, and I
won’t lie to my lord tonight.
6 If you will follow the words of your
handmaid, God will bring the thing to
pass perfectly with you; and my lord will
not fail to accomplish his purposes.
7 As Nebuchadnezzar king of all the
earth lives, and as his power lives, who
has sent you for the preservation of every
living thing, not only do men serve him by
you, but also the beasts of the field, the
cattle, and the birds of the sky will live
through your strength, in the time of
Nebuchadnezzar and of all his house.
8 For we have heard of your wisdom and
the subtle plans of your soul. It has been
reported in all the earth that you only are
brave in all the kingdom, mighty in
knowledge, and wonderful in feats of war.
9 And now as concerning the matter
which Achior spoke in your council, we
have heard his words; for the men of
Bethulia saved him, and he declared to
them all that he had spoken before you.
10 Therefore, O lord and master, don’t
neglect his word, but lay it up in your
heart, for it is true; for our race will not be
punished, neither will the sword prevail
against them, unless they sin against their
God.
11 And now, that my lord may not be
defeated and frustrated in his purpose,
and that death may fall upon them, their
sin has overtaken them, wherewith they
will provoke their God to anger,

† **10:16** Gr. *if.*

whenever they do wickedness.
12 Since their food failed them, and all their water was scant, they took counsel to kill their livestock, and determined to consume all those things which God charged them by his laws that they should not eat.
13 They are resolved to spend the first fruits of the grain and the tithes of the wine and the oil, which they had sanctified and reserved for the priests who stand before the face of our God in Jerusalem, which it is not fitting for any of the people so much as to touch with their hands.
14 They have sent some to Jerusalem, because they also that dwell there have done this thing, to bring them permission from the council of elders.
15 When these instructions come to them and they do it, they will be given to you to be destroyed the same day.
16 Therefore I your servant, knowing all this, fled away from their presence. God sent me to work things with you, at which all the earth will be astonished, even as many as hear it.
17 For your servant is religious, and serves the God of heaven day and night. Now, my lord, I will stay with you; and your servant will go out by night into the valley. I will pray to God, and he will tell me when they have committed their sins.
18 Then I will come and tell you. Then you can go out with all your army, and there will be none of them that will resist you.
19 And I will lead you through the midst of Judea, until you come to Jerusalem. I will set your throne in the midst of it. You will drive them as sheep that have no shepherd, and a dog will not so much as open his mouth before you; for these things were told me according to my foreknowledge, and were declared to me, and I was sent to tell you."
20 Her words were pleasing in the sight of Holofernes and of all his servants. They marveled at her wisdom, and said,
21 "There is not such a woman from one end of the earth to the other, for beauty of face and wisdom of words."
22 Holofernes said to her, "God did well to send you before the people, that might would be in our hands, and destruction among those who slighted my lord.
23 And now you are beautiful in your countenance, and wise in your words. If you will do as you have spoken, your God will be my God, and you will dwell in the palace of King Nebuchadnezzar, and will be renowned through the whole earth."

12

1 He commanded that she should be brought in where his silver vessels were set, and asked that his servants should prepare some of his own delicacies for her, and that she should drink from his own wine.
2 And Judith said, "I can't eat of it, lest there be an occasion of stumbling; but provision will be made for me from the things that have come with me."
3 And Holofernes said to her, "But if the things that are with you should run out, from where will we be able to give you more like it? For there is none of your race with us."
4 And Judith said to him, "As your soul lives, my lord, your servant will not use up those things that are with me until the Lord works by my hand the things that he has determined."
5 Then Holofernes' servants brought her into the tent, and she slept until midnight. Then she rose up toward the morning watch,
6 and sent to Holofernes, saying, "Let my lord now command that they allow your servant to go out to pray."
7 Holofernes commanded his guards that they should not stop her. She stayed in the camp three days, and went out every night into the valley of Bethulia and washed herself at the fountain of water in the camp.
8 And when she came up, she implored the Lord God of Israel to direct her way to the triumph of the children of his people.
9 She came in clean and remained in the tent until she ate her food toward evening.
10 It came to pass on the fourth day, that Holofernes made a feast for his own

servants only, and called none of the officers to the banquet.
11 And he said to Bagoas the eunuch, who had charge over all that he had, “Go now, and persuade this Hebrew woman who is with you that she come to us, and eat and drink with us.
12 For behold, it would be a disgrace if we shall let such a woman go, not having had her company; for if we don’t draw her to ourselves, she will laugh us to scorn.”

13 Bagoas went from the presence of Holofernes, and came in to her, and said, “Let this fair lady not fear to come to my lord, and to be honored in his presence, and to drink wine and be merry with us, and to be made this day as one of the daughters of the children of Asshur who serve in Nebuchadnezzar’s palace.”

14 Judith said to him, “Who am I, that I should contradict my lord? For whatever would be pleasing in his eyes, I will do speedily, and this will be my joy to the day of my death.”
15 She arose, and decked herself with her apparel and all her woman’s attire; and her servant went and laid fleeces on the ground for her next to Holofernes, which she had received from Bagoas for her daily use, that she might sit and eat upon them.

16 Judith came in and sat down, and Holofernes’ heart was ravished with her. His passion was aroused, and he exceedingly desired her company. He was watching for a time to deceive her from the day that he had seen her.
17 Holofernes said to her, “Drink now, and be merry with us.”

18 Judith said, “I will drink now, my lord, because my life is magnified in me this day more than all the days since I was born.”
19 Then she took and ate and drank before him what her servant had prepared.
20 Holofernes took great delight in her, and drank exceedingly much wine, more than he had drunk at any time in one day since he was born.

13

1 But when the evening had come, his servants hurried to depart. Bagoas shut the tent outside, and dismissed those who waited from the presence of his lord. They went away to their beds; for they were all weary, because the feast had been long.
2 But Judith was left alone in the tent, with Holofernes lying along upon his bed; for he was drunk with wine.
3 Judith had said to her servant that she should stand outside her bedchamber, and wait for her to come out, as she did daily; for she said she would go out to her prayer. She spoke to Bagoas according to the same words.
4 All went away from her presence, and none was left in the bedchamber, small or great. Judith, standing by his bed, said in her heart, O Lord God of all power, look in this hour upon the works of my hands for the exaltation of Jerusalem.
5 For now is the time to help your inheritance, and to do the thing that I have purposed to the destruction of the enemies which have risen up against us.
6 She came to the bedpost which was at Holofernes’ head, and took down his sword from there.
7 She drew near to the bed, took hold of the hair of his head, and said, “Strengthen me, O Lord God of Israel, this day.”
8 She struck twice upon his neck with all her might and cut off his head,
9 tumbled his body down from the bed, and took down the canopy from the posts. After a little while she went out, and gave Holofernes’ head to her maid;
10 and she put it in her bag of food. They both went out together to prayer, according to their custom. They passed through the camp, circled around that valley, and went up to the mountain of Bethulia, and came to its gates.

11 Judith said afar off to the watchmen at the gates, “Open, open the gate, now. God is with us, even our God, to show his power yet in Israel, and his might against the enemy, as he has done even this day.”

12 It came to pass, when the men of her city heard her voice, they made haste to

go down to the gate of their city, and they called together the elders of the city.
13 They all ran together, both small and great, for it seemed unbelievable to them that she had come. They opened the gate and received them, making a fire to give light, and surrounded them.
14 She said to them with a loud voice, “Praise God! Praise him! Praise God, who has not taken away his mercy from the house of Israel, but has destroyed our enemies by my hand tonight!”
15 Then she took the head out of the bag and showed it, and said to them, “Behold, the head of Holofernes, the chief captain of the army of Asshur, and behold, the canopy under which he laid in his drunkenness. The Lord struck him by the hand of a woman.
16 And as the Lord lives, who preserved me in my way that I went, my countenance deceived him to his destruction, and he didn’t commit sin with me, to defile and shame me.”
17 All the people were exceedingly amazed, and bowed themselves, and worshiped God, and said with one accord, “Blessed are you, O our God, who have this day humiliated the enemies of your people.”
18 Ozias said to her, “Blessed are you, daughter, in the sight of the Most High God, above all the women upon the earth; and blessed is the Lord God, who created the heavens and the earth, who directed you to cut off the head of the prince of our enemies.
19 For your hope will not depart from the heart of men that remember the strength of God forever.
20 May God turn these things to you for a perpetual praise, to visit you with good things, because you didn’t spare your life by reason of the affliction of our race, but prevented our ruin, walking a straight way before our God.”
And all the people said, “Amen! Amen!”

14

1 Judith said to them, “Hear me now, my kindred, and take this head, and hang it upon the battlement of your wall.
2 It will be, so soon as the morning appears, and the sun comes up on the earth, you shall each take up his weapons of war, and every valiant man of you go out of the city. You shall set a captain over them, as though you would go down to the plain toward the watch of the children of Asshur; but you men shall not go down.
3 These will take up their full armor, and shall go into their camp and rouse up the captains of the army of Asshur. They will run together to Holofernes’ tent. They won’t find him. Fear will fall upon them, and they will flee before your face.
4 You men, and all that inhabit every border of Israel, shall pursue them and overthrow them as they go.
5 But before you do these things, summon Achior the Ammonite to me, that he may see and know him that despised the house of Israel, and that sent him to us, as it were to death.
6 And they called Achior out of the house of Ozias; but when he came, and saw the head of Holofernes in a man’s hand in the assembly of the people, he fell upon his face, and his spirit failed.
7 But when they had recovered him,† he fell at Judith’s feet, bowed down to her, and said, “Blessed are you in every tent of Judah! In every nation, those who hear your name will be troubled.
8 Now tell me all the things that you have done in these days.”
And Judith declared to him in the midst of the people all the things that she had done, from the day that she went out until the time that she spoke to them.
9 But when she finished speaking, the people shouted with a loud voice, and made a joyful noise in their city.
10 But when Achior saw all the things that the God of Israel had done, he believed in God exceedingly, and circumcised the flesh of his foreskin, and was joined to the house of Israel, to this day.

† **14:7** Many authorities read *he had recovered himself.*

11 But as soon as the morning arose,
they hanged the head of Holofernes upon
the wall, and every man took up his
weapons, and they went forth by bands to
the ascents of the mountain.
12 But when the children of Asshur saw
them, they sent word to their leaders, and
they went to their captains and tribunes,
and to every one of their rulers.
13 They came to Holofernes' tent, and
said to him that was over all that he had,
"Wake our lord up, now, for the slaves
have been bold to come down against us
to battle, that they may be utterly
destroyed."
14 Bagoas went in, and knocked at the
outer door of the tent; for he supposed
that Holofernes was sleeping with Judith.
15 But when no one answered, he
opened it, went into the bedchamber, and
found him cast upon the threshold dead;
and his head had been taken from him.
16 He cried with a loud voice, with
weeping, groaning, and shouting, and
tore his garments.
17 He entered into the tent where Judith
lodged, and he didn't find her. He leaped
out to the people, and cried aloud,
18 "The slaves have dealt treacherously!
One woman of the Hebrews has brought
shame upon the house of King
Nebuchadnezzar; for, behold, Holofernes
lies upon the ground, and his head is not
on him!"
19 But when the rulers of the army of
Asshur heard this, they tore their tunics,
and their souls were troubled
exceedingly. There were cries and an
exceedingly great noise in the midst of the
camp.

15

1 When those who were in the tents
heard, they were amazed at what
happened.
2 Trembling and fear fell upon them,
and no man dared stay any more in the
sight of his neighbor, but rushing out with
one accord, they fled into every way of the
plain and of the hill country.
3 Those who had encamped in the hill
country round about Bethulia fled away.
And then the children of Israel, every one
who was a warrior among them, rushed
out upon them.
4 Ozias sent to Betomasthaim, Bebai,
Chobai, and Chola, and to every border of
Israel, to tell about the things that had
been accomplished, and that all should
rush upon their enemies to destroy them.
5 But when the children of Israel heard
this, they all fell upon them with one
accord, and struck them to Chobai. Yes,
and in like manner also, people from
Jerusalem and from all the hill country
came (for men had told them about what
happened in their enemies' camp), and
those who were in Gilead and in Galilee
fell upon their flank with a great
slaughter, until they were past Damascus
and its borders.
6 The rest of the people who lived at
Bethulia fell upon the camp of Asshur,
and plundered them, and were enriched
exceedingly.
7 The children of Israel returned from
the slaughter, and got possession of that
which remained. The villages and the
cities that were in the hill country and in
the plain country took many spoils; for
there was an exceedingly great supply.
8 Joakim the high priest, and the elders
of the children of Israel who lived in
Jerusalem, came to see the good things
which the Lord had showed to Israel, and
to see Judith and to greet her.
9 When they came to her, they all
blessed her with one accord, and said to
her, "You are the exaltation of Jerusalem!
You are the great glory of Israel! You are
the great rejoicing of our race!
10 You have done all these things by
your hand. You have done with Israel the
things that are good, and God is pleased
with it. May you be blessed by the
Almighty Lord forever!"
And all the people said, "Amen!"
11 And the people plundered the camp
for thirty days; and they gave Holofernes'
tent to Judith, along with all his silver
cups, his beds, his bowls, and all his
furniture. She took them, placed them on
her mule, prepared her wagons, and piled
them on it.

12 And all the women of Israel ran
together to see her; and they blessed her,
and made a dance among them for her.
She took branches in her hand, and
distributed them to the women who were
with her.†
13 Then they made themselves garlands
of olive, she and those who were with her,
and she went before all the people in the
dance, leading all the women. All the men
of Israel followed in their armor with
garlands, and with songs in their mouths.

16

1 And Judith began to sing this song of
thanksgiving in all Israel, and all the
people sang with loud voices this song of
praise.
2 Judith said,
"Begin a song to my God with timbrels.
Sing to my Lord with cymbals.
Make melody to him with psalm and
praise.
Exalt him, and call upon his name.
3 For the Lord is the God that crushes
battles.
For in his armies in the midst of the
people,
he delivered me out of the hand of
those who persecuted me.
4 Asshur came out of the mountains from
the north.
He came with ten thousands of his
army.
Its multitude stopped the torrents.
Their horsemen covered the hills.
5 He said that he would burn up my
borders,
kill my young men with the sword,
throw my nursing children to the
ground,
give my infants up as prey,
and make my virgins a plunder.

6 "The Almighty Lord brought them to
nothing by the hand of a woman.
7 For their mighty one didn't fall by
young men,
neither did sons of the Titans strike
him.
Tall giants didn't attack him,
but Judith the daughter of Merari
made him weak with the beauty of
her countenance.

8 "For she put off the apparel of her
widowhood
for the exaltation of those who were
distressed in Israel.
She anointed her face with ointment,
bound her hair in a tiara,
and took a linen garment to deceive
him.
9 Her sandal ravished his eye.
Her beauty took his soul prisoner.
The sword passed through his neck.
10 "The Persians quaked at her daring.
The Medes were daunted at her
boldness.

11 "Then my lowly ones shouted aloud.
My oppressed people were terrified
and trembled for fear.
They lifted up their voices and the
enemy fled.
12 The children of slave-girls pierced them
through,
and wounded them as fugitives'
children.
They perished by the army of my
Lord.

13 "I will sing to my God a new song:
O Lord, you are great and glorious,
marvelous in strength, invincible.
14 Let all your creation serve you;
for you spoke, and they were made.
You sent out your spirit, and it built them.
There is no one who can resist your
voice.
15 For the mountains will be moved from
their foundations with the waters,
and the rocks will melt as wax at your
presence:
But you are yet merciful to those who
fear you.
16 For all sacrifice is little for a sweet savor,
and all the fat is very little for a whole
burnt offering to you;
but he who fears the Lord is great
continually.

† **15:12** Compare 2 Maccabees 10:7.

17 “Woe to the nations who rise up against
my race!
The Lord Almighty will take
vengeance on them in the day of
judgment
and put fire and worms in their flesh;
and they will weep and feel their pain
forever.”
18 Now when they came to Jerusalem,
they worshiped God. When the people
were purified, they offered their whole
burnt offerings, their free will offerings,
and their gifts.
19 Judith dedicated all Holofernes’ stuff,
which the people had given her, and gave
the canopy, which she had taken for
herself out of his bedchamber, for a gift to
the Lord.
20 And the people continued feasting in
Jerusalem before the sanctuary for three
months, and Judith remained with them.
21 After these days, everyone departed
to his own inheritance. Judith went away
to Bethulia, and remained in her own
possession, and was honorable in her
time in all the land.
22 Many desired her, but no man knew
her all the days of her life from the day
that Manasses her husband died and was
gathered to his people.
23 She increased in greatness
exceedingly; and she grew old in her
husband’s house, to one hundred five
years. She let her maid go free. Then she
died in Bethulia. They buried her in the
cave of her husband Manasses.
24 The house of Israel mourned for her
seven days. She distributed her goods
before she died to all those who were
nearest of kin to Manasses her husband,
and to those who were nearest of her own
kindred.
25 There was no one who made the
children of Israel afraid any more in the
days of Judith, nor for a long time after
her death.

Esther
translated from the Greek Septuagint

Introduction

The book of Esther in the Greek Septuagint contains 5 additions that the traditional Hebrew text doesn't have. These additions are recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches. Those additions are enclosed in [square brackets]. Because the additions by themselves make little sense without the broader context of the book, we present here a translation of the whole book of Esther from the Greek.

We have chosen not to distract the reader with confusing out-of-order chapter numbers that would result from using the KJV versification, but rather merge these 5 additions as extensions at the beginning of 1:1 and after 3:13, 4:17, 8:12, and 10:3. This makes some verses (1:1, 5:1, and 8:12) really long, but it also makes the verses line up with the same verse numbers in Esther as translated from the traditional Hebrew text. Some of the proper names in this book have been changed to the more familiar Hebrew form instead of the direct transliteration from the Greek.

1 [In the second year of the reign of Ahasuerus the great king, on the first day of Nisan, Mordecai the son of Jair, the son of Shimei, the son of Kish, of the tribe of Benjamin, a Jew dwelling in the city Susa, a great man, serving in the king's palace, saw a vision. Now he was one of the captives whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had carried captive from Jerusalem with Jeconiah the king of Judea. This was his dream: Behold, voices and a noise, thunders and earthquake, tumult upon the earth. And, behold, two great serpents came out, both ready for conflict. A great voice came from them. Every nation was prepared for battle by their voice, even to fight against the nation of the just. Behold, a day of darkness and blackness, suffering and anguish, affection and tumult upon the earth. And all the righteous nation was troubled, fearing their own afflictions. They prepared to die, and cried to God. Something like a great river from a little spring with much water, came from their cry. Light and the sun arose, and the lowly were exalted, and devoured the honorable.

Mordecai, who had seen this vision and what God desired to do, having arisen, kept it in his heart, and desired by all means to interpret it, even until night.

Mordecai rested quietly in the palace with Gabatha and Tharrha the king's two chamberlains, eunuchs who guarded the palace. He heard their conversation and searched out their plans. He learned that they were preparing to lay hands on King Ahasuerus; and he informed the king concerning them. The king examined the two chamberlains. They confessed, and were led away and executed. The king wrote these things for a record. Mordecai also wrote concerning these matters. The king commanded Mordecai to serve in the palace, and gave gifts for this service. But Haman the son of Hammedatha the Bougean was honored in the sight of the king, and he endeavored to harm Mordecai and his people, because of the king's two chamberlains.]

†And it came to pass after these things‡ in the days of Ahasuerus, —(this Ahasuerus ruled over one hundred twenty-seven provinces from India)—

2 in those days, when King Ahasuerus was on the throne in the city of Susa,

3 in the third year of his reign, he made a feast for his friends, for people from the rest of the nations, for the nobles of the Persians and Medes, and for the chief of the local governors.

4 After this—after he had shown them the wealth of his kingdom and the abundant glory of his wealth during one hundred eighty days—

† **1:1** *Note:* In the *Hebrew* and some copies of LXX, Esther begins here. ‡ **1:1** *Greek* words.

5 when the days of the wedding feast
were completed, the king made a banquet
lasting six days for the people of the
nations who were present in the city, in
the court of the king's house,
6 which was adorned with fine linen
and flax on cords of fine linen and purple,
fastened to golden and silver studs on
pillars of white marble and stone. There
were golden and silver couches on a
pavement of emerald stone, and of
mother-of-pearl, and of white marble,
with transparent coverings variously
flowered, having roses arranged around
it.
7 There were gold and silver cups, and a
small cup of carbuncle set out, of the
value of thirty thousand talents, with
abundant and sweet wine, which the king
himself drank.
8 This banquet was not according to the
appointed law, but as the king desired to
have it. He charged the stewards to
perform his will and that of the company.
9 Also Vashti the queen made a banquet
for the women in the palace where King
Ahasuerus lived.
10 Now on the seventh day, the king,
being merry, told Haman, Bazan,
Tharrha, Baraze, Zatholtha, Abataza, and
Tharaba, the seven chamberlains,
servants of King Ahasuerus,
11 to bring in the queen to him, to§
enthrone her, and crown her with the
diadem, and to show her to the princes,
and her beauty to the nations, for she was
beautiful.
12 But queen Vashti refused to come
with the chamberlains; so the king was
grieved and angered.
13 And he said to his friends, "This is
what Vashti said. Therefore pronounce
your legal judgment on this case."
14 So Arkesaeus, Sarsathaeus, and
Malisear, the princes of the Persians and
Medes, who were near the king, who sat
chief in rank by the king, drew near to
him,
15 and reported to him according to the
laws what it was proper to do to queen
Vashti, because she had not done the
things commanded by the king through
the chamberlains.
16 And Memucan said to the king and to
the princes, "Queen Vashti has not
wronged the king only, but also all the
king's rulers and princes;
17 for he has told them the words of the
queen, and how she† disobeyed the king.
As she then refused to obey King
Ahasuerus,
18 so this day the other wives of the
chiefs of the Persians and Medes, having
heard what she said to the king, will dare
in the same way to dishonor their
husbands.
19 If then it seems good to the king, let
him make a royal decree, and let it be
written according to the laws of the
Medes and Persians, and let him not alter
it: 'Don't allow the queen to come in to
him any more. Let the king give her
royalty to a woman better than she.'
20 Let the law of the king which he will
have made be widely proclaimed in his
kingdom. Then all the women will give
honor to their husbands, from the poor
even to the rich."
21 This advice pleased the king and the
princes; and the king did as Memucan had
said,
22 and sent into all his kingdom through
the several provinces, according to their
language, so that men might be feared in
their own houses.

2

1 After this, the king's anger was
pacified, and he no more mentioned
Vashti, bearing in mind what she had said,
and how he had condemned her.
2 Then the servants of the king said, "Let
chaste, beautiful young virgins be sought
for the king.
3 Let the king appoint local governors in
all the provinces of his kingdom, and let
them select beautiful, chaste young ladies
and bring them to the city Susa, into the
women's apartment. Let them be
consigned to the king's chamberlain, the
keeper of the women. Then let things for

§ **1:11** *Greek* to make her queen. † **1:17** *Greek* contradicted.

purification and other needs be given to them.
4 Let the woman who pleases the king be queen instead of Vashti."

This thing pleased the king; and he did so.
5 Now there was a Jew in the city Susa, and his name was Mordecai, the son of Jairus, the son of Shimei, the son of Kish, of the tribe of Benjamin.
6 He had been brought as a prisoner from Jerusalem, whom Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon had carried into captivity.
7 He had a foster child, daughter of Aminadab his father's brother. Her name was Esther. When her parents died, he brought her up to womanhood as his own. This lady was beautiful.
8 And because the king's ordinance was published, many ladies were gathered to the city of Susa under the hand of Hegai; and Esther was brought to Hegai, the keeper of the women.
9 The lady pleased him, and she found favor in his sight. He hurried to give her the things for purification, her portion, and the seven maidens appointed her out of the palace. He treated her and her maidens well in the women's apartment.
10 But Esther didn't reveal her family or her kindred, for Mordecai had charged her not to tell.
11 But Mordecai used to walk every day by the women's court, to see what would become of Esther.
12 Now this was the time for a virgin to go into the king, when she had completed twelve months; for so are the days of purification fulfilled, six months while they are anointing themselves with oil of myrrh, and six months with spices and women's purifications.
13 And then the lady goes in to the king. The officer that he commands to do so will bring her to come in with him from the women's apartment to the king's chamber.
14 She enters in the evening, and in the morning she departs to the second women's apartment, where Hegai the king's chamberlain is keeper of the women. She doesn't go in to the king again, unless she is called by name.
15 And when the time was fulfilled for Esther the daughter of Aminadab the brother of Mordecai's father to go in to the king, she neglected nothing which the chamberlain, the women's keeper, commanded; for Esther found grace in the sight of all who looked at her.
16 So Esther went in to King Ahasuerus in the twelfth month, which is Adar, in the seventh year of his reign.
17 The king loved Esther, and she found favor beyond all the other virgins. He put the queen's crown on her.
18 The king made a banquet for all his friends and great men for seven days, and he highly celebrated the marriage of Esther; and he granted a remission of taxes to those who were under his dominion.
19 Meanwhile, Mordecai served in the courtyard.
20 Now Esther had not revealed her country, for so Mordecai commanded her, to fear God, and perform his commandments, as when she was with him. Esther didn't change her manner of life.
21 Two chamberlains of the king, the chiefs of the body-guard, were grieved, because Mordecai was promoted; and they sought to kill King Ahasuerus.
22 And the matter was discovered by Mordecai, and he made it known to Esther, and she declared to the king the matter of the conspiracy.
23 And the king examined the two chamberlains and hanged them. Then the king gave orders to make a note for a memorial in the royal library of the goodwill shown by Mordecai, as a commendation.

3

1 After this, King Ahasuerus highly honored Haman the son of Hammedatha, the Bugaean. He exalted him and set his seat above all his friends.
2 All in the palace bowed down to him, for so the king had given orders to do; but Mordecai didn't bow down to him.

3 And they in the king's palace said to
Mordecai, "Mordecai, why do you
transgress the commands of the king?"
4 They questioned him daily, but he
didn't listen to them; so they reported to
Haman that Mordecai resisted the
commands of the king; and Mordecai had
shown to them that he was a Jew.
5 When Haman understood that
Mordecai didn't bow down to him, he was
greatly enraged,
6 and plotted to utterly destroy all the
Jews who were under the rule of
Ahasuerus.
7 In the twelfth year of the reign of
Ahasuerus, Haman made a decision by
casting lots by day and month, to kill the
race of Mordecai in one day. The lot fell on
the fourteenth day of the month of Adar.
8 So he spoke to King Ahasuerus, saying,
"There is a nation scattered among the
nations in all your kingdom, and their
laws differ from all the other nations.
They disobey the king's laws. It is not
expedient for the king to tolerate them.
9 If it seem good to the king, let him
make a decree to destroy them, and I will
remit into the king's treasury ten
thousand talents of silver."
10 So the king took off his ring, and gave
it into the hands of Haman to seal the
decrees against the Jews.
11 The king said to Haman, "Keep the
silver, and treat the nation as you will."
12 So the king's recorders were called in
the first month, on the thirteenth day, and
they wrote as Haman commanded to the
captains and governors in every province,
from India even to Ethiopia, to one
hundred twenty-seven provinces; and to
the rulers of the nations according to their
languages, in the name of King Ahasuerus.
13 The message was sent by couriers
throughout the kingdom of Ahasuerus, to
utterly destroy the race of the Jews on the
first day of the twelfth month, which is
Adar, and to plunder their goods.† [The
following is the copy of the letter. "From
the great King Ahasuerus to the rulers and
the governors under them of one hundred
twenty-seven provinces, from India even
to Ethiopia, who hold authority under
him:

"Ruling over many nations and having
obtained dominion over the whole world,
I was determined (not elated by the
confidence of power, but ever conducting
myself with great moderation and
gentleness) to make the lives of my
subjects continually tranquil, desiring
both to maintain the kingdom quiet and
orderly to its utmost limits, and to restore
the peace desired by all men. When I had
asked my counselors how this should be
brought to pass, Haman, who excels in
soundness of judgment among us, and has
been manifestly well inclined without
wavering and with unshaken fidelity, and
had obtained the second post in the
kingdom, informed us that a certain
ill-disposed people is scattered among all
the tribes throughout the world, opposed
in their law to every other nation, and
continually neglecting the commands of
the king, so that the united government
blamelessly administered by us is not
quietly established. Having then
conceived that this nation is continually
set in opposition to every man,
introducing as a change a foreign code of
laws, and injuriously plotting to
accomplish the worst of evils against our
interests, and against the happy
establishment of the monarchy, we
instruct you in the letter written by
Haman, who is set over the public affairs
and is our second governor, to destroy
them all utterly with their wives and
children by the swords of the enemies,
without pitying or sparing any, on the
fourteenth day of the twelfth month Adar,
of the present year; that the people
aforetime and now ill-disposed to us
having been violently consigned to death
in one day, may hereafter secure to us
continually a well constituted and quiet
state of affairs."]
14 Copies of the letters were published
in every province; and an order was given

† **3:13** *Note:* The part in brackets is not in *Hebrew*

to all the nations to be ready for that day.
15 This business was hastened also in Susa. The king and Haman began to drink, but the city was confused.

4

1 But Mordecai, having perceived what was done, tore his garments, put on sackcloth, and sprinkled dust upon himself. Having rushed forth through the open street of the city, he cried with a loud voice, “A nation that has done no wrong is going to be destroyed!”
2 He came to the king’s gate, and stood; for it was not lawful for him to enter into the palace wearing sackcloth and ashes.
3 And in every province where the letters were published, there was crying, lamentation, and great mourning on the part of the Jews. They wore sackcloth and ashes.
4 The queen’s maids and chamberlains went in and told her; and when she had heard what was done, she was deeply troubled. She sent clothes to Mordecai to replace his sackcloth, but he refused.
5 So Esther called for her chamberlain Hathach, who waited upon her; and she sent to learn the truth from Mordecai.
7 Mordecai showed him what was done, and the promise which Haman had made the king of ten thousand talents to be paid into the treasury, that he might destroy the Jews.
8 And he gave him the copy of what was published in Susa concerning their destruction to show to Esther; and told him to charge her to go in and entreat the king, and to beg him for the people. “Remember, he said, the days of your humble condition, how you were nursed by my hand; because Haman, who holds the next place to the king, has spoken against us to cause our death. Call upon the Lord, and speak to the king concerning us, to deliver us from death.”
9 So Hathach went in and told her all these words.
10 Esther said to Hathach, “Go to Mordecai, and say,
11 ‘All the nations of the empire know that any man or woman who goes in to the king into the inner court without being called, that person must die, unless the king stretches out his golden sceptre; then he shall live. I haven’t been called to go into the king for thirty days.’ ”
12 So Hathach reported to Mordecai all the words of Esther.
13 Then Mordecai said to Hathach, “Go, and say to her, ‘Esther, don’t say to yourself that you alone will escape in the kingdom, more than all the other Jews.
14 For if you keep quiet on this occasion, help and protection will come to the Jews from another place; but you and your father’s house will perish. Who knows if you have been made queen for this occasion?’ ”
15 And Esther sent the messenger who came to her to Mordecai, saying,
16 “Go and assemble the Jews that are in Susa, and all of you fast for me. Don’t eat or drink for three days, night and day. My maidens and I will also fast. Then I will go in to the king contrary to the law, even if I must die.”
17 So Mordecai went and did all that Esther commanded him.†
18 [He prayed to the Lord, making mention of all the works of the Lord.
19 He said, “Lord God, you are king ruling over all, for all things are in your power, and there is no one who can oppose you in your purpose to save Israel;
20 for you have made the sky and the earth and every wonderful thing under the sky.
21 You are Lord of all, and there is no one who can resist you, Lord.
22 You know all things. You know, Lord, that it is not in insolence, nor arrogance, nor love of glory, that I have done this, to refuse to bow down to the arrogant Haman.
23 For I would gladly have kissed the soles of his feet for the safety of Israel.
24 But I have done this that I might not set the glory of man above the glory of God. I will not worship anyone except

† **4:17** Note: The part between brackets, *i.e.* to the end of chapter 5 is not in the Hebrew

you, my Lord, and I will not do these things in arrogance.
25 And now, O Lord God, the King, the God of Abraham, spare your people, for our enemies are planning our destruction, and they have desired to destroy your ancient inheritance.
26 Do not overlook your people, whom you have redeemed for yourself out of the land of Egypt.
27 Listen to my prayer. Have mercy on your inheritance and turn our mourning into gladness, that we may live and sing praise to your name, O Lord. Don't utterly destroy the mouth of those who praise you, O Lord."
28 All Israel cried with all their might, for death was before their eyes.
29 And queen Esther took refuge in the Lord, being taken as it were in the agony of death.
30 Having taken off her glorious apparel, she put on garments of distress and mourning. Instead of grand perfumes she filled her head with ashes and dung. She greatly humbled her body, and she filled every place of her glad adorning with her tangled hair.
31 She implored the Lord God of Israel, and said, "O my Lord, you alone are our king. Help me. I am destitute, and have no helper but you,
32 for my danger is near at hand‡.
33 I have heard from my birth in the tribe of my kindred that you, Lord, took Israel out of all the nations, and our fathers out of all their kindred for a perpetual inheritance, and have done for them all that you have said.
34 And now we have sinned before you, and you have delivered us into the hands of our enemies,
35 because we honored their gods. You are righteous, O Lord.
36 But now they have not been content with the bitterness of our slavery, but have laid their hands on the hands of their idols
37 to abolish the decree of your mouth, and utterly to destroy your inheritance, and to stop the mouth of those who praise you, and to extinguish the glory of your house and your altar,
38 and to open the mouth of the Gentiles to speak the§ praises of vanities, and that a mortal king should be admired forever.
39 O Lord, don't surrender your sceptre to those who don't exist, and don't let them laugh at our fall, but turn their counsel against themselves, and make an example of him who has begun to injure us.
40 Remember us, O Lord! Manifest yourself in the time of our affliction. Encourage me, O King of gods, and ruler of all dominion!
41 Put harmonious speech into my mouth before the lion, and turn his heart to hate him who fights against us, to the utter destruction of those who agree with him.
42 But deliver us by your hand, and help me who am alone and have no one but you, O Lord.
43 You know all things, and know that I hate the glory of transgressors,† and that I abhor the bed of the uncircumcised and of every stranger.
44 You know my necessity, for I abhor the symbol of my proud station, which is upon my head in the days of my‡ splendor. I abhor it as a menstruous cloth, and I don't wear it in the days of my tranquility.
45 Your handmaid has not eaten at Haman's table, and I have not honored the banquet of the king, neither have I drunk wine of libations.
46 Neither has your handmaid rejoiced since the day of my promotion until now, except in you, O Lord God of Abraham.
47 O god, who has power over all, listen to the voice of the desperate, and deliver us from the hand of those who devise mischief. Deliver me from my fear.]

5

1 †It came to pass on the third day, when she had ceased praying, that she took off

‡ **4:32** *Greek* in my hand. § **4:38** *Greek* virtues. † **4:43** *Or,* opinion. ‡ **4:44** *Greek* vision. † **5:1** From the first verse to the third, the *Greek widely differs from the Hebrew*

her servant's dress and put on her glorious apparel. Being splendidly dressed and having called upon God the Overseer and Preserver of all things, she took her two maids, and she leaned upon one, as a delicate female, and the other followed bearing her train. She was blooming in the perfection of her beauty. Her face was cheerful and looked lovely, but her heart was filled with fear. Having passed through all the doors, she stood before the king. He was sitting on his royal throne. He had put on all his glorious apparel, covered all over with gold and precious stones, and was very terrifying. And having raised his face resplendent with glory, he looked with intense anger. The queen fell, and changed her color as she fainted. She bowed herself upon the head of the maid who went before her. But God changed the spirit of the king to gentleness, and in intense feeling, he sprang from off his throne, and took her into his arms, until she recovered. He comforted her with peaceful words, and said to her, "What is the matter, Esther? I am your relative. Cheer up! You shall not die, for our command is openly declared to you: 'Draw near.' "

2 And having raised the golden sceptre, he laid it upon her neck, and embraced her. He said, "Speak to me."

So she said to him, "I saw you, my lord, as an angel of God, and my heart was troubled for fear of your glory; for you, my lord, are to be wondered at, and your face is full of grace." While she was speaking, she fainted and fell.

Then the king was troubled, and all his servants comforted her.

3 The king said, "What do you desire, Esther? What is your request? Ask even to the half of my kingdom, and it shall be yours."

4 Esther said, "Today is a special day. So if it seems good to the king, let both him and Haman come to the feast which I will prepare this day."

5 The king said, "Hurry and bring Haman here, that we may do as Esther said." So they both came to the feast about which Esther had spoken.

6 At the banquet, the king said to Esther, "What is your request, queen Esther? You shall have all that you require."

7 She said, "My request and my petition is:

8 if I have found favor in the king's sight, let the king and Haman come again tomorrow to the feast which I shall prepare for them, and tomorrow I will do as I have done today."

9 So Haman went out from the king very glad and merry; but when Haman saw Mordecai the Jew in the court, he was greatly enraged.

10 Having gone into his own house, he called his friends, and his wife Zeresh.

11 He showed them his wealth and the glory with which the king had invested him, and how he had promoted him to be chief ruler in the kingdom.

12 Haman said, "The queen has called no one to the feast with the king but me, and I am invited tomorrow.

13 But these things don't please me while I see Mordecai the Jew in the court.

14 Then Zeresh his wife and his friends said to him, "Let a fifty cubit tall‡ gallows be made for you. In the morning you speak to the king, and let Mordecai be hanged on the gallows; but you go in to the feast with the king, and be merry."

The saying pleased Haman, and the gallows was prepared.

6

1 The Lord removed sleep from the king that night; so he told his servant to bring in the† books, the registers of daily events, to read to him.

2 And he found the‡ records written concerning Mordecai, how he had told the king about the king's two chamberlains, when they were keeping guard, and sought to lay hands on Ahasuerus.

3 The king said, "What honor or favor have we done for Mordecai?"

‡ **5:14** *Greek* a tree cut. † **6:1** *Greek* letters. ‡ **6:2** *Greek* letters.

The king's servants said, "You haven't done anything for him."

4 And while the king was enquiring about the kindness of Mordecai, behold, Haman was in the court. The king said, "Who is in the court? Now Haman had come in to speak to the king about hanging Mordecai on the gallows which he had prepared.

5 The king's servants said, "Behold, Haman stands in the court."

And the king said, "Call him!"

6 The king said to Haman, "What should I do for the man whom I wish to honor?"

Haman said within himself, "Whom would the king honor but myself?"

7 He said to the king, "As for the man whom the king wishes to honor,

8 let the king's servants bring the robe of fine linen which the king puts on, and the horse on which the king rides,

9 and let him give it to one of the king's noble friends, and let him dress the man whom the king loves. Let him mount him on the horse, and proclaim through the§ streets of the city, saying, "This is what will be done for every man whom the king honors!"

10 Then the king said to Haman, "You have spoken well. Do so for Mordecai the Jew, who waits in the palace, and let not a word of what you have spoken be neglected!"

11 So Haman took the robe and the horse, dressed Mordecai, mounted him on the horse, and went through the streets of the city, proclaiming, "This is what will be done for every man whom the king wishes to honor."

12 Then Mordecai returned to the palace; but Haman went home mourning, with his head covered.

13 Haman related the events that had happened to him to Zeresh his wife and to his friends. His friends and his wife said to him, "If Mordecai is of the race of the Jews, and you have begun to be humbled before him, you will assuredly fall; and you will not be able to withstand him, for the living God is with him."

14 While they were still speaking, the chamberlains arrived to rush Haman to the banquet which Esther had prepared.

7

1 So the king and Haman went in to drink with the queen.

2 The king said to Esther at the banquet on the second day, "What is it, queen Esther? What is your request? What is your petition? It shall be done for you, up to half of my kingdom."

3 She answered and said, "If I have found favor in the sight of the king, let my life be granted as my petition, and my people as my request.

4 For both I and my people are sold for destruction, pillage, and genocide. If both we and our children were sold for male and female slaves, I would not have bothered you, for this† isn't worthy of the king's palace."

5 The king said, "Who has dared to do this thing?"

6 Esther said, "The enemy is Haman, this wicked man!"

Then Haman was terrified in the presence of the king and the queen.

7 The king rose up from the banquet to go into the garden. Haman began to beg the queen for mercy, for he saw that he was in serious trouble.

8 The king returned from the garden; and Haman had fallen upon the couch, begging the queen for mercy. The king said, "Will you even assault my wife in my house?"

And when Haman heard it, he changed countenance.

9 And Bugathan, one of the chamberlains, said to the king, "Behold, Haman has also prepared a gallows for Mordecai, who spoke concerning the king, and a fifty cubit high gallows has been set up on Haman's property."

The king said, "Let him be‡ hanged on it!"

10 So Haman was hanged on the gallows that had been prepared for Mordecai. Then the king's wrath was abated.

§ **6:9** *Or,* wide space. † **7:4** see *Hebrew: slanderer* ‡ **7:9** *Or,* impaled.

8

1 On that day, King Ahasuerus gave to
Esther all that belonged to Haman the
slanderer. The king called Mordecai, for
Esther had told that he was related to her.
2 The king took the ring which he had
taken away from Haman and gave it to
Mordecai. Esther appointed Mordecai
over all that had been Haman's.
3 She spoke yet again to the king, and
fell at his feet, and implored him to undo
Haman's mischief and all that he had
done against the Jews.
4 Then the king extended the golden
sceptre to Esther; and Esther arose to
stand near the king.
5 Esther said, "If it seems good to you,
and I have found favor in your sight, let
an order be sent that the letters sent by
Haman may be reversed—letters that
were written for the destruction of the
Jews who are in your kingdom.
6 For how could I see the affliction of my
people, and how could I survive the
destruction of my† kindred?"

7 Then the king said to Esther, "If I have
given and freely granted you all that was
Haman's, and hanged him on a gallows
because he laid his hands upon the Jews,
what more do you seek?
8 Write in my name whatever seems
good to you, and seal it with my ring; for
whatever is written at the command of
the king, and sealed with my ring, cannot
be countermanded.
9 So the scribes were called in the first
month, which is Nisan, on the
twenty-third day of the same year; and
orders were written to the Jews, whatever
the king had commanded to the‡ local
governors and chiefs of the local
governors, from India even to
Ethiopia—one hundred twenty-seven
local governors, according to the several
provinces, in their own languages.
10 They were written by order of the
king, sealed with his ring, and the letters
were sent by the couriers.
11 In them, he charged them to use their
own laws in every city, to help each other,
and to treat their adversaries and those
who attacked them as they pleased,
12 on one day in all the kingdom of
Ahasuerus, on the thirteenth day of the
twelfth month, which is Adar.
13 Let the copies be posted in
conspicuous places throughout the
kingdom. Let all the Jews be ready against
this day, to fight against their enemies.
The following is a copy of the letter
containing orders:

§[The great King Ahasuerus sends
greetings to the rulers of provinces in one
hundred twenty-seven local governance
regions, from India to Ethiopia, even to
those who are faithful to our interests.
Many who have been frequently honored
by the most abundant kindness of their†
benefactors have conceived ambitious
designs, and not only endeavor to hurt
our subjects, but moreover, not being able
to bear prosperity, they also endeavor to
plot against their own benefactors. They
not only would utterly abolish gratitude
from among men, but also, elated by the
boastings of men who are strangers to all
that is good, they supposed that they
would escape the sin-hating vengeance of
the ever-seeing God. And oftentimes evil
exhortation has made partakers of the
guilt of shedding innocent blood, and has
involved in irremediable calamities many
of those who had been appointed to
offices of authority, who had been
entrusted with the management of their
friends' affairs; while men, by the false
sophistry of an evil disposition, have
deceived the simple goodwill of the ruling
powers. And it is possible to see this, not
so much from more ancient traditional
accounts, as it is immediately in your
power to see it by examining what things
have been wickedly‡ perpetrated by the
baseness of men unworthily holding
power. It is right to take heed with regard
to the future, that we may maintain the
government in undisturbed peace for all

† **8:6** *Greek* country. ‡ **8:9** *Greek* stewards. § **8:13** the passages in brackets are not in the *Hebrew.* † **8:13** perhaps rulers, see Luke 22. 25. ‡ **8:13** *Greek* contrived.

men, adopting needful changes, and ever judging those cases which come under our notice with truly equitable decisions. For whereas Haman, a Macedonian, the son of Hammedatha, in reality an alien from the blood of the Persians, and differing widely from our mild course of government, having been hospitably entertained by us, obtained so large a share of our universal kindness as to be called our father, and to continue the person next to the royal throne, reverenced of all; he however, overcome by§ pride, endeavored to deprive us of our dominion, and our life;† having by various and subtle artifices demanded for destruction both Mordecai our deliverer and perpetual benefactor, and Esther the blameless consort of our kingdom, along with their whole nation. For by these methods he thought, having surprised us in a defenseless state, to transfer the dominion of the Persians to the Macedonians. But we find that the Jews, who have been consigned to destruction by the‡ most abominable of men, are not malefactors, but living according to the most just laws, and being the sons of the living God, the most high and§ mighty, who maintains the kingdom, to us as well as to our forefathers, in the most excellent order. You will therefore do well in refusing to obey the letter sent by Haman the son of Hammedatha, because he who has done these things has been hanged with his whole family at the gates of Susa, Almighty God having swiftly returned to him a worthy punishment. We enjoin you then, having openly published a copy of this letter in every place, to give the Jews permission to use their own lawful customs and to strengthen them, that on the thirteenth of the twelfth month Adar, on the self-same day, they may defend themselves against those who attack them in a time of affliction. For in the place of the destruction of the chosen race, Almighty God has granted them this time of gladness. Therefore you also, among your notable feasts, must keep a distinct day with all festivity, that both now and hereafter it may be a day of deliverance to us and who are well disposed toward the Persians, but to those that plotted against us a memorial of destruction. And every city and province collectively, which shall not do accordingly, shall be consumed with vengeance by spear and fire. It shall be made not only inaccessible to men, but most hateful to wild beasts and birds forever.] Let the copies be posted in conspicuous places throughout the kingdom and let all the Jews be ready against this day, to fight against their enemies.

14 So the horsemen went forth with haste to perform the king's commands. The ordinance was also published in Susa.

15 Mordecai went out robed in royal apparel, wearing a golden crown and a diadem of fine purple linen. The people in Susa saw it and rejoiced.

16 The Jews had light and gladness

17 in every city and province where the ordinance was published. Wherever the proclamation took place, the Jews had joy and gladness, feasting and mirth. Many of the Gentiles were circumcised and became Jews for fear of the Jews.

9

1 Now in the twelfth month, on the thirteenth day of the month, which is Adar, the letters written by the king arrived.

2 In that day, the adversaries of the Jews perished; for no one resisted, through fear of them.

3 For the chiefs of the local governors, and the princes and the royal scribes, honored the Jews; for the fear of Mordecai was upon them.

4 For the order of the king was in force, that he should be celebrated in all the kingdom.

6 In the city Susa the Jews killed five hundred men,

7 including Pharsannes, Delphon, Phasga,

8 Pharadatha, Barea, Sarbaca,

§ **8:13** *Greek* not having borne. † **8:13** *Greek* spirit. ‡ **8:13** *Greek* thrice guilty. § **8:13** *Greek* greatest.

9 Marmasima, Ruphaeus, Arsaeus, and Zabuthaeus,
10 the ten sons of Haman the son of Hammedatha the Bugaean, the enemy of the Jews; and they plundered their property on the same day.
11 The number of those who perished in Susa was reported to the king.

12 Then the king said to Esther, “The Jews have slain five hundred men in the city Susa. What do you think they have done in the rest of the country? What more do you ask, that it may be done for you?”

13 Esther said to the king, “Let it be granted to the Jews to do the same to them tomorrow. Also, hang the bodies of the ten sons of Haman.”
14 He permitted it to be done; and he gave up to the Jews of the city the bodies of the sons of Haman to hang.
15 The Jews assembled in Susa on the fourteenth day of Adar and killed three hundred men, but plundered no property.

16 The rest of the Jews who were in the kingdom assembled, and helped one another, and obtained rest from their enemies; for they destroyed fifteen thousand of them on the thirteenth day of Adar, but took no spoil.
17 They rested on the fourteenth of the same month, and kept it as a day of rest with joy and gladness.

18 The Jews in the city of Susa assembled also on the fourteenth day and rested; and they also observed the fifteenth with joy and gladness.
19 On this account then, the Jews dispersed in every foreign land keep the fourteenth of Adar as a† holy day with joy, each sending gifts of food to his neighbor.

20 Mordecai wrote these things in a book and sent them to the Jews, as many as were in the kingdom of Ahasuerus, both those who were near and those who were far away,
21 to establish these as joyful days and to keep the fourteenth and fifteenth of Adar;
22 for on these days the Jews obtained rest from their enemies; and in that month, which was Adar, in which a change was made for them from mourning to joy, and from sorrow to a holiday, to spend the whole of it in good days of‡ feasting and gladness, sending portions to their friends and to the poor.
23 And the Jews consented to this as Mordecai wrote to them,
24 showing how Haman the son of Hammedatha the Macedonian fought against them, how he made a decree and cast§ lots to destroy them utterly;
25 also how he went in to the king, telling him to hang Mordecai; but all the calamities he tried to bring upon the Jews came upon himself, and he was hanged, along with his children.
26 Therefore these days were called Purim, because of the lots (for in their language they are called Purim) because of the words of this letter, and because of all they suffered on this account, and all that happened to them.
27 Mordecai established it, and the Jews took upon themselves, upon their offspring, and upon those who were joined to them to observe it, neither would they on any account behave differently; but these days were to be a memorial kept in every generation, city, family, and province.
28 These days of Purim shall be kept forever, and their memorial shall not fail in any generation.
29 Queen Esther the daughter of Aminadab and Mordecai the Jew wrote all that they had done, and gave the confirmation of the letter about Purim.
31 Mordecai and Esther the queen established this decision on their own, pledging their own well-being to their plan.
32 And Esther established it by a command forever, and it was written for a memorial.

10

1 The king levied a tax upon his

† **9:19** *Greek* good day. ‡ **9:22** *Greek* weddings. § **9:24** *Greek* lot.

kingdom both by land and sea.
2 As for his strength and valour, and the
wealth and glory of his kingdom, behold,
they are written in the book of the
Persians and Medes for a memorial.
3 Mordecai† was viceroy to King
Ahasuerus, and was a great man in the
kingdom, honored by the Jews, and lived
his life loved by all his nation.‡
4 [Mordecai said, “These things have
come from God.
5 For I remember the dream which I had
concerning these matters; for not one
detail of them has failed.
6 There was the little spring which
became a river, and there was light, and
the sun and much water. The river is
Esther, whom the king married and made
queen.
7 The two serpents are Haman and me.
8 The nations are those which combined
to destroy the name of the Jews.
9 But as for my nation, this is Israel,
even those who cried to God and were
delivered; for the Lord delivered his
people. The Lord rescued us out of all
these calamities; and God worked such
signs and great wonders as have not been
done among the nations.
10 Therefore he ordained two lots. One
for the people of God, and one for all the
other nations.
11 And these two lots came for an
appointed season, and for a day of
judgment, before God, and for all the
nations.
12 God remembered his people and
vindicated his inheritance.
13 They shall observe these days in the
month Adar, on the fourteenth and on the
fifteenth day of the month, with an
assembly, joy, and gladness before God,
throughout the generations forever
among his people Israel.
14 In the fourth year of the reign of
Ptolemeus and Cleopatra, Dositheus, who
said he was a priest and Levite, and
Ptolemeus his son brought this letter of
Purim, which they said was authentic, and
that Lysimachus the son of Ptolemeus,
who was in Jerusalem, had interpreted.]

† **10:3** *Greek* succeded to *Or, came into the place of.* ‡ **10:3** the passages in brackets are not in the *Hebrew.*

The Book of Daniel with Greek Portions

1 In the third year of the reign of
Jehoiakim king of Judah, Nebuchadnezzar
king of Babylon came to Jerusalem and
besieged it.
2 The Lord† gave Jehoiakim king of
Judah into his hand, with part of the
vessels of the house of God;‡ and he
carried them into the land of Shinar to the
house of his god. He brought the vessels
into the treasure house of his god.
3 The king spoke to Ashpenaz the master
of his eunuchs, that he should bring in
some of the children of Israel, even of the
royal offspring§ and of the nobles—
4 youths in whom was no defect, but
well-favored, and skillful in all wisdom,
and endowed with knowledge, and
understanding science, and who had the
ability to serve in the king's palace; and
that he should teach them the learning
and the language of the Chaldeans.
5 The king appointed for them a daily
portion of the king's delicacies, and of the
wine which he drank, and that they
should be nourished three years; that at
its end they should serve the king.
6 Now among these were of the children
of Judah: Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and
Azariah.
7 The prince of the eunuchs gave names
to them: to Daniel he gave the name
Belteshazzar; to Hananiah, Shadrach; to
Mishael, Meshach; and to Azariah,
Abednego.
8 But Daniel purposed in his heart that
he would not defile himself with the
king's delicacies, nor with the wine which
he drank. Therefore he requested of the
prince of the eunuchs that he might not
defile himself.
9 Now God made Daniel find kindness
and compassion in the sight of the prince
of the eunuchs.
10 The prince of the eunuchs said to
Daniel, "I fear my lord the king, who has
appointed your food and your drink. For
why should he see your faces worse
looking than the youths who are of your
own age? Then you would endanger my
head with the king."
11 Then Daniel said to the steward
whom the prince of the eunuchs had
appointed over Daniel, Hananiah,
Mishael, and Azariah:
12 "Test your servants, I beg you, ten
days; and let them give us vegetables to
eat and water to drink.
13 Then let our faces be examined
before you, and the face of the youths who
eat of the king's delicacies; and as you see,
deal with your servants."
14 So he listened to them in this matter,
and tested them for ten days.
15 At the end of ten days, their faces
appeared fairer, and they were fatter in
flesh, than all the youths who ate of the
king's delicacies.
16 So the steward took away their
delicacies, and the wine that they would
drink, and gave them vegetables.
17 Now as for these four youths, God
gave them knowledge and skill in all
learning and wisdom; and Daniel had
understanding in all visions and dreams.
18 At the end of the days which the king
had appointed for bringing them in, the
prince of the eunuchs brought them in
before Nebuchadnezzar.
19 The king talked with them; and
among them all was found no one like
Daniel, Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah.
Therefore they served the king.
20 In every matter of wisdom and
understanding concerning which the king
inquired of them, he found them ten
times better than all the magicians and
enchanters who were in all his realm.
21 Daniel continued serving even to the
first year of King Cyrus.

2

1 In the second year of the reign of
Nebuchadnezzar, Nebuchadnezzar

† **1:2** The word translated "Lord" is "Adonai." ‡ **1:2** The Hebrew word rendered "God" is "אֱלֹהִים" (Elohim). § **1:3** or, seed

dreamed dreams; and his spirit was troubled, and his sleep went from him.
2 Then the king commanded that the magicians, the enchanters, the sorcerers, and the Chaldeans be called to tell the king his dreams. So they came in and stood before the king.
3 The king said to them, “I have dreamed a dream, and my spirit is troubled to know the dream.”
4 Then the Chaldeans spoke to the king in the Syrian language, “O king, live forever! Tell your servants the dream, and we will show the interpretation.”
5 The king answered the Chaldeans, “The thing has gone from me. If you don’t make known to me the dream and its interpretation, you will be cut in pieces, and your houses will be made a dunghill.
6 But if you show the dream and its interpretation, you will receive from me gifts, rewards, and great honor. Therefore show me the dream and its interpretation.”
7 They answered the second time and said, “Let the king tell his servants the dream, and we will show the interpretation.”
8 The king answered, “I know of a certainty that you are trying to gain time, because you see the thing has gone from me.
9 But if you don’t make known to me the dream, there is but one law for you; for you have prepared lying and corrupt words to speak before me, until the situation changes. Therefore tell me the dream, and I will know that you can show me its interpretation.”
10 The Chaldeans answered before the king, and said, “There is not a man on the earth who can show the king’s matter, because no king, lord, or ruler, has asked such a thing of any magician, enchanter, or Chaldean.
11 It is a rare thing that the king requires, and there is no other who can show it before the king, except the gods, whose dwelling is not with flesh.”
12 Because of this, the king was angry and very furious, and commanded that all the wise men of Babylon be destroyed.
13 So the decree went out, and the wise men were to be slain. They sought Daniel and his companions to be slain.
14 Then Daniel returned answer with counsel and prudence to Arioch the captain of the king’s guard, who had gone out to kill the wise men of Babylon.
15 He answered Arioch the king’s captain, “Why is the decree so urgent from the king?” Then Arioch made the thing known to Daniel.
16 Daniel went in, and desired of the king that he would appoint him a time, and he would show the king the interpretation.
17 Then Daniel went to his house and made the thing known to Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah, his companions,
18 that they would desire mercies of the God of heaven concerning this secret, and that Daniel and his companions would not perish with the rest of the wise men of Babylon.
19 Then the secret was revealed to Daniel in a vision of the night. Then Daniel blessed the God of heaven.
20 Daniel answered,
“Blessed be the name of God forever and ever;
for wisdom and might are his.
21 He changes the times and the seasons.
He removes kings and sets up kings.
He gives wisdom to the wise,
and knowledge to those who have understanding.
22 He reveals the deep and secret things.
He knows what is in the darkness,
and the light dwells with him.
23 I thank you and praise you,
O God of my fathers,
who have given me wisdom and might,
and have now made known to me what we desired of you;
for you have made known to us the king’s matter.”
24 Therefore Daniel went in to Arioch, whom the king had appointed to destroy the wise men of Babylon. He went and said this to him: “Don’t destroy the wise men of Babylon. Bring me in before the king, and I will show to the king the interpretation.”

25 Then Arioch brought in Daniel before
the king in haste, and said this to him: "I
have found a man of the children of the
captivity of Judah who will make known
to the king the interpretation."
26 The king answered Daniel, whose
name was Belteshazzar, "Are you able to
make known to me the dream which I
have seen, and its interpretation?"
27 Daniel answered before the king, and
said, "The secret which the king has
demanded can't be shown to the king by
wise men, enchanters, magicians, or
soothsayers;
28 but there is a God in heaven who
reveals secrets, and he has made known
to King Nebuchadnezzar what will be in
the latter days. Your dream, and the
visions of your head on your bed, are
these:
29 "As for you, O king, your thoughts
came on your bed, what should happen
hereafter; and he who reveals secrets has
made known to you what will happen.
30 But as for me, this secret is not
revealed to me for any wisdom that I have
more than any living, but to the intent
that the interpretation may be made
known to the king, and that you may
know the thoughts of your heart.
31 "You, O king, saw, and behold,† a
great image. This image, which was
mighty, and whose brightness was
excellent, stood before you; and its
appearance was terrifying.
32 As for this image, its head was of fine
gold, its chest and its arms of silver, its
belly and its thighs of bronze,
33 its legs of iron, its feet part of iron,
and part of clay.
34 You saw until a stone was cut out
without hands, which struck the image on
its feet that were of iron and clay, and
broke them in pieces.
35 Then the iron, the clay, the bronze,
the silver, and the gold were broken in
pieces together, and became like the chaff
of the summer threshing floors. The wind
carried them away, so that no place was
found for them. The stone that struck the
image became a great mountain, and
filled the whole earth.
36 "This is the dream; and we will tell its
interpretation before the king.
37 You, O king, are king of kings, to
whom the God of heaven has given the
kingdom, the power, the strength, and the
glory.
38 Wherever the children of men dwell,
he has given the animals of the field and
the birds of the sky into your hand, and
has made you rule over them all. You are
the head of gold.
39 "After you, another kingdom will
arise that is inferior to you; and a third
kingdom of bronze, which will rule over
all the earth.
40 The fourth kingdom will be strong as
iron, because iron breaks in pieces and
subdues all things; and as iron that
crushes all these, it will break in pieces
and crush.
41 Whereas you saw the feet and toes,
part of potters' clay, and part of iron, it
will be a divided kingdom; but there will
be in it of the strength of the iron, because
you saw the iron mixed with miry clay.
42 As the toes of the feet were part of
iron, and part of clay, so the kingdom will
be partly strong, and partly brittle.
43 Whereas you saw the iron mixed with
miry clay, they will mingle themselves
with the seed of men; but they won't cling
to one another, even as iron does not mix
with clay.
44 "In the days of those kings the God of
heaven will set up a kingdom which will
never be destroyed, nor will its
sovereignty be left to another people; but
it will break in pieces and consume all
these kingdoms, and it will stand forever.
45 Because you saw that a stone was cut
out of the mountain without hands, and
that it broke in pieces the iron, the bronze,
the clay, the silver, and the gold. The great
God has made known to the king what
will happen hereafter. The dream is
certain, and its interpretation sure."

† **2:31** "Behold", from "הֲנָה", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

46 Then King Nebuchadnezzar fell on
his face, worshiped Daniel, and
commanded that they should offer an
offering and sweet odors to him.
47 The king answered to Daniel, and
said, “Of a truth your God is the God of
gods, and the Lord of kings, and a revealer
of secrets, since you have been able to
reveal this secret.”
48 Then the king made Daniel great, and
gave him many great gifts, and made him
rule over the whole province of Babylon,
and to be chief governor over all the wise
men of Babylon.
49 Daniel requested of the king, and he
appointed Shadrach, Meshach, and
Abednego over the affairs of the province
of Babylon; but Daniel was in the king’s
gate.

3

1 Nebuchadnezzar the king made an
image of gold, whose height was sixty
cubits,† and its width six cubits. He set it
up in the plain of Dura, in the province of
Babylon.
2 Then Nebuchadnezzar the king sent to
gather together the local governors, the
deputies, and the governors, the judges,
the treasurers, the counselors, the
sheriffs, and all the rulers of the
provinces, to come to the dedication of the
image which Nebuchadnezzar the king
had set up.
3 Then the local governors, the deputies,
and the governors, the judges, the
treasurers, the counselors, the sheriffs,
and all the rulers of the provinces, were
gathered together to the dedication of the
image that Nebuchadnezzar the king had
set up; and they stood before the image
that Nebuchadnezzar had set up.
4 Then the herald cried aloud, “To you it
is commanded, peoples, nations, and
languages,
5 that whenever you hear the sound of
the horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, pipe,
and all kinds of music, you fall down and
worship the golden image that
Nebuchadnezzar the king has set up.
6 Whoever doesn’t fall down and
worship shall be cast into the middle of a
burning fiery furnace the same hour.”
7 Therefore at that time, when all the
peoples heard the sound of the horn, flute,
zither, lyre, harp, pipe, and all kinds of
music, all the peoples, the nations, and the
languages, fell down and worshiped the
golden image that Nebuchadnezzar the
king had set up.
8 Therefore at that time certain
Chaldeans came near, and brought
accusation against the Jews.
9 They answered Nebuchadnezzar the
king, “O king, live for ever!
10 You, O king, have made a decree that
every man who hears the sound of the
horn, flute, zither, lyre, harp, pipe, and all
kinds of music shall fall down and
worship the golden image;
11 and whoever doesn’t fall down and
worship shall be cast into the middle of a
burning fiery furnace.
12 There are certain Jews whom you
have appointed over the affairs of the
province of Babylon: Shadrach, Meshach,
and Abednego. These men, O king, have
not respected you. They don’t serve your
gods, and don’t worship the golden image
which you have set up.”
13 Then Nebuchadnezzar in rage and
fury commanded that Shadrach,
Meshach, and Abednego be brought. Then
these men were brought before the king.
14 Nebuchadnezzar answered them, “Is
it on purpose, Shadrach, Meshach, and
Abednego, that you don’t serve my god,
nor worship the golden image which I
have set up?
15 Now if you are ready whenever you
hear the sound of the horn, flute, zither,
lyre, harp, pipe, and all kinds of music to
fall down and worship the image which I
have made, good; but if you don’t
worship, you shall be cast the same hour
into the middle of a burning fiery furnace.

† **3:1** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man’s arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

Who is that god who will deliver you out of my hands?"

16 Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego answered the king, "Nebuchadnezzar, we have no need to answer you in this matter.

17 If it happens, our God whom we serve is able to deliver us from the burning fiery furnace; and he will deliver us out of your hand, O king.

18 But if not, let it be known to you, O king, that we will not serve your gods or worship the golden image which you have set up."

19 Then Nebuchadnezzar was full of fury, and the form of his appearance was changed against Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego. He spoke, and commanded that they should heat the furnace seven times more than it was usually heated.

20 He commanded certain mighty men who were in his army to bind Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, and to cast them into the burning fiery furnace.

21 Then these men were bound in their pants, their tunics, their mantles, and their other clothes, and were cast into the middle of the burning fiery furnace.

22 Therefore because the king's commandment was urgent, and the furnace exceedingly hot, the flame of the fire killed those men who took up Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego.

23 These three men, Shadrach, Meshach, and Abednego, fell down bound into the middle of the burning fiery furnace.

THE SONG OF THE THREE HOLY CHILDREN‡

24 They walked in the midst of the fire, praising God, and blessing the Lord.

25 Then Azarias stood, and prayed like this. Opening his mouth in the midst of the fire he said,

26 "Blessed are you, O Lord, you God of our fathers! Your name is worthy to be praised and glorified for evermore;

27 for you are righteous in all the things that you have done. Yes, all your works are true. Your ways are right, and all your judgments are truth.

28 In all the things that you have brought upon us, and upon the holy city of our fathers, Jerusalem, you have executed true judgments. For according to truth and justice you have brought all these things upon us because of our sins.

29 For we have sinned and committed iniquity in departing from you.

30 In all things we have trespassed, and not obeyed your commandments or kept them. We haven't done as you have commanded us, that it might go well with us.

31 Therefore all that you have brought upon us, and everything that you have done to us, you have done in true judgment.

32 You delivered us into the hands of lawless enemies, most hateful rebels, and to an unjust king who is the most wicked in all the world.

33 And now we can't open our mouth. Shame and reproach have come on your servants and those who worship you.

34 Don't utterly deliver us up, for your name's sake. Don't annul your covenant.

35 Don't cause your mercy to depart from us, for the sake of Abraham who is loved by you, and for the sake of Isaac your servant, and Israel your holy one,

36 to whom you promised that you would multiply their offspring as the stars of the sky, and as the sand that is on the sea shore.

37 For we, O Lord, have become less than any nation, and are brought low this day in all the world because of our sins.

38 There isn't at this time prince, or prophet, or leader, or burnt offering, or sacrifice, or oblation, or incense, or place to offer before you, and to find mercy.

39 Nevertheless in a contrite heart and a humble spirit let us be accepted,

‡ **3:23** *The Song of the Three Holy Children* is an addition to *Daniel* found in the Greek Septuagint but not found in the traditional Hebrew text of *Daniel*. This portion is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches. It is found inserted between Daniel 3:23 and Daniel 3:24 of the traditional Hebrew Bible. Here, the verses after 23 from the Hebrew Bible are numbered starting at 91 to make room for these verses.

40 like the burnt offerings of rams and
bullocks, and like ten thousands of fat
lambs. So let our sacrifice be in your sight
this day, that we may wholly go after you,
for they shall not be ashamed who put
their trust in you.
41 And now we follow you with all our
heart. We fear you, and seek your face.
42 Put us not to shame; but deal with us
after your kindness, and according to the
multitude of your mercy.
43 Deliver us also according to your
marvelous works, and give glory to your
name, O Lord. Let all those who harm
your servants be confounded.
44 Let them be ashamed of all their
power and might, and let their strength be
broken.
45 Let them know that you are the Lord,
the only God, and glorious over the whole
world."
46 The king's servants who put them in
didn't stop making the furnace hot with
naphtha, pitch, tinder, and small wood,
47 so that the flame streamed out forty
nine cubits above the furnace.
48 It spread and burned those Chaldeans
whom it found around the furnace.
49 But the angel of the Lord came down
into the furnace together with Azarias
and his fellows, and he struck the flame of
the fire out of the furnace,
50 and made the midst of the furnace as
it had been a moist whistling wind, so that
the fire didn't touch them at all. It neither
hurt nor troubled them.
51 Then the three, as out of one mouth,
praised, glorified, and blessed God in the
furnace, saying,
52 "Blessed are you, O Lord, you God of
our fathers, to be praised and exalted
above all forever!
53 Blessed is your glorious and holy
name, to be praised and exalted above all
forever!
54 Blessed are you in the temple of your
holy glory, to be praised and glorified
above all forever!
55 Blessed are you who see the depths
and sit upon the cherubim, to be praised
and exalted above all forever.
56 Blessed are you on the throne of your
kingdom, to be praised and extolled above
all forever!
57 Blessed are you in the firmament of
heaven, to be praised and glorified
forever!
58 O all you works of the Lord, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
59 O you heavens, bless the Lord! Praise
and exalt him above all for ever!
60 O you angels of the Lord, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
61 O all you waters that are above the
sky, bless the Lord! Praise and exalt him
above all forever!
62 O all you powers of the Lord, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
63 O you sun and moon, bless the Lord!
Praise and exalt him above all forever!
64 O you stars of heaven, bless the Lord!
Praise and exalt him above all forever!
65 O every shower and dew, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
66 O all you winds, bless the Lord! Praise
and exalt him above all forever!
67 O you fire and heat, bless the Lord!
Praise and exalt him above all forever!
68 O you dews and storms of snow, bless
the Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
69 O you nights and days, bless the Lord!
Praise and exalt him above all forever!
70 O you light and darkness, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
71 O you cold and heat, bless the Lord!
Praise and exalt him above all forever!
72 O you frost and snow, bless the Lord!
Praise and exalt him above all forever!
73 O you lightnings and clouds, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
74 O let the earth bless the Lord! Let it
praise and exalt him above all forever!
75 O you mountains and hills, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
76 O all you things that grow on the
earth, bless the Lord! Praise and exalt him
above all forever!

§ **3:77** Some authorities transpose this verse and the next one.

77 §O sea and rivers, bless the Lord!
Praise and exalt him above all forever!
78 O you springs, bless the Lord! Praise
and exalt him above all forever!
79 O you whales and all that move in the
waters, bless the Lord! Praise and exalt
him above all forever!
80 O all you birds of the air, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
81 O all you beasts and cattle, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
82 O you children of men, bless the Lord!
Praise and exalt him above all forever!
83 O let Israel bless the Lord! Praise and
exalt him above all forever.
84 O you priests of the Lord, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
85 O you servants of the Lord, bless the
Lord! Praise and exalt him above all
forever!
86 O you spirits and souls of the
righteous, bless the Lord! Praise and exalt
him above all forever!
87 O you who are holy and humble of
heart, bless the Lord! Praise and exalt him
above all forever!
88 O Hananiah, Mishael, and Azariah,
bless the Lord! Praise and exalt him
above all forever; for he has rescued us
from Hades, and saved us from the hand
of death! He has delivered us out of the
midst of the furnace and burning flame.
He has delivered us out of the midst of the
fire.
89 O give thanks to the Lord, for he is
good; for his mercy is forever.
90 O all you who worship the Lord, bless
the God of gods, praise him, and give him
thanks; for his mercy is forever!"

Deliverance from the Furnace

91 †Then Nebuchadnezzar the king was
astonished and rose up in haste. He spoke
and said to his counselors, "Didn't we cast
three men bound into the middle of the
fire?"
They answered the king, "True, O king."
92 He answered, "Look, I see four men
loose, walking in the middle of the fire,
and they are unharmed. The appearance
of the fourth is like a son of the gods."
93 Then Nebuchadnezzar came near to
the mouth of the burning fiery furnace.
He spoke and said, "Shadrach, Meshach,
and Abednego, you servants of the Most
High God, come out, and come here!"
Then Shadrach, Meshach, and
Abednego came out of the middle of the
fire.
94 The local governors, the deputies, and
the governors, and the king's counselors,
being gathered together, saw these men,
that the fire had no power on their bodies.
The hair of their head wasn't singed.
Their pants weren't changed. The smell of
fire wasn't even on them.
95 Nebuchadnezzar spoke and said,
"Blessed be the God of Shadrach,
Meshach, and Abednego, who has sent his
angel and delivered his servants who
trusted in him, and have changed the
king's word, and have yielded their
bodies, that they might not serve nor
worship any god, except their own God.
96 Therefore I make a decree, that every
people, nation, and language, who speak
anything evil against the God of Shadrach,
Meshach, and Abednego, shall be cut in
pieces, and their houses shall be made a
dunghill, because there is no other god
who is able to deliver like this."
97 Then the king promoted Shadrach,
Meshach, and Abednego in the province
of Babylon.

4

1 Nebuchadnezzar the king,
to all the peoples, nations, and
languages, who dwell in all the earth:
Peace be multiplied to you.
2 It has seemed good to me to show
the signs and wonders that the Most
High God has worked toward me.
3 How great are his signs!
How mighty are his wonders!
His kingdom is an everlasting
kingdom.
His dominion is from generation
to generation.
4 I, Nebuchadnezzar, was at rest in my
house, and flourishing in my palace.

† **3:91** Verses 91-97 were numbered 24-30 in the traditional Hebrew text of Daniel.

5 I saw a dream which made me
afraid; and the thoughts on my bed and
the visions of my head troubled me.
6 Therefore I made a decree to bring
in all the wise men of Babylon before me,
that they might make known to me the
interpretation of the dream.
7 Then the magicians, the enchanters,
the Chaldeans, and the soothsayers came
in; and I told the dream before them; but
they didn't make known to me its
interpretation.
8 But at the last Daniel came in before
me, whose name was Belteshazzar,
according to the name of my god, and in
whom is the spirit of the holy gods. I told
the dream before him, saying,
9 "Belteshazzar, master of the
magicians, because I know that the
spirit of the holy gods is in you, and no
secret troubles you, tell me the visions
of my dream that I have seen, and its
interpretation.
10 These were the visions of my head
on my bed: I saw, and behold, a tree in the
middle of the earth; and its height was
great.
11 The tree grew, and was strong, and
its height reached to the sky, and its sight
to the end of all the earth.
12 Its leaves were beautiful, and it had
much fruit, and in it was food for all. The
animals of the field had shade under it,
and the birds of the sky lived in its
branches, and all flesh was fed from it.
13 "I saw in the visions of my head on
my bed, and behold, a watcher and a
holy one came down from the sky.
14 He cried aloud, and said this, 'Cut
down the tree and cut off its branches!
Shake off its leaves and scatter its fruit!
Let the animals get away from under it,
and the fowls from its branches.
15 Nevertheless leave the stump of its
roots in the earth, even with a band of
iron and bronze, in the tender grass of the
field; and let it be wet with the dew of the
sky. Let his portion be with the animals in
the grass of the earth.
16 Let his heart be changed from
man's, and let an animal's heart be given
to him. Then let seven times pass over
him.
17 " 'The sentence is by the decree of
the watchers, and the demand by the
word of the holy ones, to the intent that
the living may know that the Most High
rules in the kingdom of men, and gives
it to whomever he will, and sets up over
it the lowest of men.'
18 "This dream I, King
Nebuchadnezzar, have seen; and you,
Belteshazzar, declare the
interpretation, because all the wise men
of my kingdom are not able to make
known to me the interpretation; but
you are able, for the spirit of the holy
gods is in you."
19 Then Daniel, whose name was
Belteshazzar, was stricken mute for a
while, and his thoughts troubled him.
The king answered, "Belteshazzar, don't
let the dream, or the interpretation,
trouble you."
Belteshazzar answered, "My lord,
may the dream be for those who hate
you, and its interpretation to your
adversaries.
20 The tree that you saw, which grew
and was strong, whose height reached to
the sky, and its sight to all the earth;
21 whose leaves were beautiful, and
its fruit plentiful, and in it was food for all;
under which the animals of the field lived,
and on whose branches the birds of the
sky had their habitation—
22 it is you, O king, who have grown
and become strong; for your greatness
has grown, and reaches to the sky, and
your dominion to the end of the earth.
23 "Whereas the king saw a watcher
and a holy one coming down from the
sky, and saying, 'Cut down the tree, and
destroy it; nevertheless leave the stump
of its roots in the earth, even with a
band of iron and bronze, in the tender
grass of the field, and let it be wet with
the dew of the sky. Let his portion be
with the animals of the field, until seven
times pass over him.'
24 "This is the interpretation, O king,
and it is the decree of the Most High,
which has come on my lord the king:

25 that you shall be driven from men,
and your dwelling shall be with the
animals of the field. You shall be made to
eat grass as oxen, and shall be wet with
the dew of the sky, and seven times shall
pass over you; until you know that the
Most High rules in the kingdom of men,
and gives it to whomever he will.
26 Their command to leave the stump
of the roots of the tree means your
kingdom will be sure to you, after you will
have known that the heavens do rule.
27 Therefore, O king, let my counsel be
acceptable to you, and break off your sins
by righteousness, and your iniquities by
showing mercy to the poor. Perhaps there
may be a lengthening of your tranquility."
28 All this came on the King
Nebuchadnezzar.
29 At the end of twelve months he was
walking in the royal palace of Babylon.
30 The king spoke and said, "Is not this
great Babylon, which I have built for the
royal dwelling place, by the might of my
power and for the glory of my majesty?"
31 While the word was in the king's
mouth, a voice came from the sky,
saying, "O King Nebuchadnezzar, to you
it is spoken: 'The kingdom has departed
from you.
32 You shall be driven from men, and
your dwelling shall be with the animals of
the field. You shall be made to eat grass as
oxen. Seven times shall pass over you,
until you know that the Most High rules in
the kingdom of men, and gives it to
whomever he will.' "
33 This was fulfilled the same hour on
Nebuchadnezzar. He was driven from
men, and ate grass as oxen, and his
body was wet with the dew of the sky,
until his hair had grown like eagles'
feathers, and his nails like birds' claws.
34 At the end of the days I,
Nebuchadnezzar, lifted up my eyes to
heaven, and my understanding
returned to me, and I blessed the Most
High, and I praised and honored him
who lives forever.
For his dominion is an everlasting
dominion,
and his kingdom from generation
to generation.
35 All the inhabitants of the earth are
reputed as nothing;
and he does according to his will
in the army of heaven,
and among the inhabitants of the
earth;
and no one can stop his hand,
or ask him, "What are you
doing?"
36 At the same time my understanding
returned to me; and for the glory of my
kingdom, my majesty and brightness
returned to me. My counselors and my
lords sought me; and I was established
in my kingdom, and excellent greatness
was added to me.
37 Now I, Nebuchadnezzar, praise and
extol and honor the King of heaven; for all
his works are right and his ways just; and
those who walk in pride he is able to
humble.

5

1 Belshazzar the king made a great feast
to a thousand of his lords, and drank wine
before the thousand.
2 Belshazzar, while he tasted the wine,
commanded that the golden and silver
vessels which Nebuchadnezzar his father
had taken out of the temple which was in
Jerusalem be brought to him, that the king
and his lords, his wives and his
concubines, might drink from them.
3 Then they brought the golden vessels
that were taken out of the temple of God's
house which was at Jerusalem; and the
king and his lords, his wives and his
concubines, drank from them.
4 They drank wine, and praised the gods
of gold, and of silver, of bronze, of iron, of
wood, and of stone.
5 In the same hour, the fingers of a
man's hand came out and wrote near the
lamp stand on the plaster of the wall of
the king's palace. The king saw the part of
the hand that wrote.
6 Then the king's face was changed in
him, and his thoughts troubled him; and
the joints of his thighs were loosened, and
his knees struck one against another.

7 The king cried aloud to bring in the enchanters, the Chaldeans, and the soothsayers. The king spoke and said to the wise men of Babylon, “Whoever reads this writing and shows me its interpretation shall be clothed with purple, and have a chain of gold about his neck, and shall be the third ruler in the kingdom.”

8 Then all the king’s wise men came in; but they could not read the writing and couldn’t make known to the king the interpretation.

9 Then King Belshazzar was greatly troubled. His face was changed in him, and his lords were perplexed.

10 The queen by reason of the words of the king and his lords came into the banquet house. The queen spoke and said, “O king, live forever; don’t let your thoughts trouble you, nor let your face be changed.

11 There is a man in your kingdom in whom is the spirit of the holy gods. In the days of your father, light, understanding, and wisdom like the wisdom of the gods were found in him. The king, Nebuchadnezzar, your father—yes, the king, your father—made him master of the magicians, enchanters, Chaldeans, and soothsayers

12 because an excellent spirit, knowledge, understanding, interpreting of dreams, showing of dark sentences, and dissolving of doubts were found in the same Daniel, whom the king named Belteshazzar. Now let Daniel be called, and he will show the interpretation.”

13 Then Daniel was brought in before the king. The king spoke and said to Daniel, “Are you that Daniel of the children of the captivity of Judah, whom the king my father brought out of Judah?

14 I have heard of you, that the spirit of the gods is in you, and that light, understanding, and excellent wisdom are found in you.

15 Now the wise men, the enchanters, have been brought in before me to read this writing, and make known to me its interpretation; but they could not show the interpretation of the thing.

16 But I have heard of you, that you can give interpretations and dissolve doubts. Now if you can read the writing, and make known to me its interpretation, you shall be clothed with purple, and have a chain of gold around your neck, and shall be the third ruler in the kingdom.”

17 Then Daniel answered the king, “Let your gifts be to yourself, and give your rewards to another. Nevertheless, I will read the writing to the king, and make known to him the interpretation.

18 “To you, king, the Most High God gave Nebuchadnezzar your father the kingdom, and greatness, and glory, and majesty.

19 Because of the greatness that he gave him, all the peoples, nations, and languages trembled and feared before him. He killed whom he wanted to, and he kept alive whom he wanted to. He raised up whom he wanted to, and he put down whom he wanted to.

20 But when his heart was lifted up, and his spirit was hardened so that he dealt proudly, he was deposed from his kingly throne, and they took his glory from him.

21 He was driven from the sons of men and his heart was made like the animals’, and his dwelling was with the wild donkeys. He was fed with grass like oxen, and his body was wet with the dew of the sky, until he knew that the Most High God rules in the kingdom of men, and that he sets up over it whomever he will.

22 “You, his son, Belshazzar, have not humbled your heart, though you knew all this,

23 but have lifted up yourself against the Lord of heaven; and they have brought the vessels of his house before you, and you and your lords, your wives, and your concubines, have drunk wine from them. You have praised the gods of silver, gold, bronze, iron, wood, and stone, which don’t see, hear, or know; and you have not glorified the God in whose hand is your breath and whose are all your ways.

24 Then the part of the hand was sent
from before him, and this writing was
inscribed.
25 "This is the writing that was
inscribed: 'MENE, MENE, TEKEL,
UPHARSIN.'
26 "This is the interpretation of the
thing:
MENE: God has counted your kingdom,
and brought it to an end.
27 TEKEL: you are weighed in the
balances, and are found wanting.
28 PERES: your kingdom is divided, and
given to the Medes and Persians."
29 Then Belshazzar commanded, and
they clothed Daniel with purple, and put a
chain of gold about his neck, and
proclaimed that he should be the third
highest ruler in the kingdom.
30 In that night Belshazzar the Chaldean
King was slain.
31 Darius the Mede received the
kingdom, being about sixty-two years old.

6

1 It pleased Darius to set over the
kingdom one hundred twenty local
governors, who should be throughout the
whole kingdom;
2 and over them three presidents, of
whom Daniel was one; that these local
governors might give account to them,
and that the king should suffer no loss.
3 Then this Daniel was distinguished
above the presidents and the local
governors, because an excellent spirit was
in him; and the king thought to set him
over the whole realm.
4 Then the presidents and the local
governors sought to find occasion against
Daniel as touching the kingdom; but they
could find no occasion or fault, because he
was faithful. There wasn't any error or
fault found in him.
5 Then these men said, "We won't find
any occasion against this Daniel, unless
we find it against him concerning the law
of his God."
6 Then these presidents and local
governors assembled together to the king,
and said this to him, "King Darius, live
forever!
7 All the presidents of the kingdom, the
deputies and the local governors, the
counselors and the governors, have
consulted together to establish a royal
statute, and to make a strong decree, that
whoever asks a petition of any god or man
for thirty days, except of you, O king, he
shall be cast into the den of lions.
8 Now, O king, establish the decree, and
sign the writing, that it not be changed,
according to the law of the Medes and
Persians, which doesn't alter."
9 Therefore King Darius signed the
writing and the decree.

10 When Daniel knew that the writing
was signed, he went into his house (now
his windows were open in his room
toward Jerusalem) and he kneeled on his
knees three times a day, and prayed, and
gave thanks before his God, as he did
before.
11 Then these men assembled together,
and found Daniel making petition and
supplication before his God.
12 Then they came near, and spoke
before the king concerning the king's
decree: "Haven't you signed a decree that
every man who makes a petition to any
god or man within thirty days, except to
you, O king, shall be cast into the den of
lions?"

The king answered, "This thing is true,
according to the law of the Medes and
Persians, which doesn't alter."

13 Then they answered and said before
the king, "That Daniel, who is of the
children of the captivity of Judah, doesn't
respect you, O king, nor the decree that
you have signed, but makes his petition
three times a day."
14 Then the king, when he heard these
words, was very displeased, and set his
heart on Daniel to deliver him; and he
labored until the going down of the sun to
rescue him.
15 Then these men assembled together
to the king, and said to the king, "Know, O
king, that it is a law of the Medes and
Persians, that no decree nor statute which
the king establishes may be changed."

16 Then the king commanded, and they
brought Daniel, and cast him into the den
of lions. The king spoke and said to
Daniel, “Your God whom you serve
continually, he will deliver you.”
17 A stone was brought, and laid on the
mouth of the den; and the king sealed it
with his own signet, and with the signet of
his lords, that nothing might be changed
concerning Daniel.
18 Then the king went to his palace, and
passed the night fasting. No musical
instruments were brought before him;
and his sleep fled from him.
19 Then the king arose very early in the
morning, and went in haste to the den of
lions.
20 When he came near to the den to
Daniel, he cried with a troubled voice. The
king spoke and said to Daniel, “Daniel,
servant of the living God, is your God,
whom you serve continually, able to
deliver you from the lions?”
21 Then Daniel said to the king, “O king,
live forever!
22 My God has sent his angel, and has
shut the lions’ mouths, and they have not
hurt me; because I am innocent in his
sight. Also before you, O king, I have done
no harm.”
23 Then the king was exceedingly glad,
and commanded that they should take
Daniel up out of the den. So Daniel was
taken up out of the den, and no kind of
harm was found on him, because he had
trusted in his God.
24 The king commanded, and they
brought those men who had accused
Daniel, and they cast them into the den of
lions—them, their children, and their
wives; and the lions mauled them and
broke all their bones in pieces before they
came to the bottom of the den.
25 Then King Darius wrote to all the
peoples, nations, and languages, who
dwell in all the earth:
“Peace be multiplied to you.
26 “I make a decree that in all the
dominion of my kingdom men tremble
and fear before the God of Daniel;
“for he is the living God,
and steadfast forever.
His kingdom is that which will not be
destroyed.
His dominion will be even to the end.
27 He delivers and rescues.
He works signs and wonders in
heaven and in earth,
who has delivered Daniel from the
power of the lions.”
28 So this Daniel prospered in the reign
of Darius, and in the reign of Cyrus the
Persian.

7

1 In the first year of Belshazzar king of
Babylon, Daniel had a dream and visions
of his head on his bed. Then he wrote the
dream and told the sum of the matters.
2 Daniel spoke and said, “I saw in my
vision by night and behold, the four winds
of the sky broke out on the great sea.
3 Four great animals came up from the
sea, different from one another.
4 “The first was like a lion, and had
eagle’s wings. I watched until its wings
were plucked, and it was lifted up from
the earth, and made to stand on two feet
as a man. A man’s heart was given to it.
5 “Behold, there was another animal, a
second, like a bear. It was raised up on
one side, and three ribs were in its mouth
between its teeth. They said this to it:
‘Arise! Devour much flesh!’
6 “After this I saw, and behold, another,
like a leopard, which had on its back four
wings of a bird. The animal also had four
heads; and dominion was given to it.
7 “After this I saw in the night visions,
and, behold, there was a fourth animal,
awesome and powerful, and exceedingly
strong. It had great iron teeth. It devoured
and broke in pieces, and stamped the
residue with its feet. It was different from
all the animals that were before it. It had
ten horns.
8 “I considered the horns, and behold,
another horn came up among them, a
little one, before which three of the first
horns were plucked up by the roots: and
behold, in this horn were eyes like the
eyes of a man, and a mouth speaking
great things.
9 “I watched until thrones were placed,
and one who was Ancient of Days sat.

His clothing was white as snow,
and the hair of his head like pure wool.
His throne was fiery flames,
and its wheels burning fire.
10 A fiery stream issued and came out from before him.
Thousands of thousands ministered to him.
Ten thousand times ten thousand stood before him.
The judgment was set.
The books were opened.
11 "I watched at that time because of the voice of the great words which the horn spoke. I watched even until the animal was slain, its body destroyed, and it was given to be burned with fire.
12 As for the rest of the animals, their dominion was taken away; yet their lives were prolonged for a season and a time.
13 "I saw in the night visions, and behold, one like a son of man came with the clouds, and he came to the Ancient of Days, and they brought him near before him.
14 Dominion was given him, with glory and a kingdom, that all the peoples, nations, and languages should serve him. His dominion is an everlasting dominion, which will not pass away, and his kingdom will not be destroyed.
15 "As for me, Daniel, my spirit was grieved within my body, and the visions of my head troubled me.
16 I came near to one of those who stood by, and asked him the truth concerning all this.
"So he told me, and made me know the interpretation of the things.
17 'These great animals, which are four, are four kings, who will arise out of the earth.
18 But the saints of the Most High will receive the kingdom, and possess the kingdom forever, even forever and ever.'
19 "Then I desired to know the truth concerning the fourth animal, which was different from all of them, exceedingly terrible, whose teeth were of iron, and its nails of bronze; which devoured, broke in pieces, and stamped the residue with its feet;
20 and concerning the ten horns that were on its head, and the other horn which came up, and before which three fell, even that horn that had eyes, and a mouth that spoke great things, whose look was more stout than its fellows.
21 I saw, and the same horn made war with the saints and prevailed against them
22 until the Ancient of Days came, and judgment was given to the saints of the Most High, and the time came that the saints possessed the kingdom.
23 "So he said, 'The fourth animal will be a fourth kingdom on earth, which will be different from all the kingdoms, and will devour the whole earth, and will tread it down, and break it in pieces.
24 As for the ten horns, ten kings will arise out of this kingdom. Another will arise after them; and he will be different from the former, and he will put down three kings.
25 He will speak words against the Most High, and will wear out the saints of the Most High. He will plan to change the times and the law; and they will be given into his hand until a time and times and half a time.
26 " 'But the judgment will be set, and they will take away his dominion, to consume and to destroy it to the end.
27 The kingdom and the dominion, and the greatness of the kingdoms under the whole sky, will be given to the people of the saints of the Most High. His kingdom is an everlasting kingdom, and all dominions will serve and obey him.'
28 "Here is the end of the matter. As for me, Daniel, my thoughts troubled me greatly, and my face was changed in me; but I kept the matter in my heart."

8

1 In the third year of the reign of King Belshazzar, a vision appeared to me, even to me, Daniel, after that which appeared to me at the first.
2 I saw the vision. Now it was so, that when I saw, I was in the citadel of Susa, which is in the province of Elam. I saw in the vision, and I was by the river Ulai.

3 Then I lifted up my eyes, and saw, and behold, a ram which had two horns stood before the river. The two horns were high; but one was higher than the other, and the higher came up last.
4 I saw the ram pushing westward, northward, and southward. No animals could stand before him. There wasn't anyone who could deliver out of his hand; but he did according to his will, and magnified himself.
5 As I was considering, behold, a male goat came from the west over the surface of the whole earth, and didn't touch the ground. The goat had a notable horn between his eyes.
6 He came to the ram that had the two horns, which I saw standing before the river, and ran on him in the fury of his power.
7 I saw him come close to the ram, and he was moved with anger against him, and struck the ram, and broke his two horns. There was no power in the ram to stand before him; but he cast him down to the ground, and trampled on him. There was no one who could deliver the ram out of his hand.
8 The male goat magnified himself exceedingly. When he was strong, the great horn was broken; and instead of it there came up four notable horns toward the four winds of the sky.
9 Out of one of them came out a little horn, which grew exceedingly great, toward the south, and toward the east, and toward the glorious land.
10 It grew great, even to the army of the sky; and it cast down some of the army and of the stars to the ground, and trampled on them.
11 Yes, it magnified itself, even to the prince of the army; and it took away from him the continual burnt offering, and the place of his sanctuary was cast down.
12 The army was given over to it together with the continual burnt offering through disobedience. It cast down truth to the ground, and it did its pleasure and prospered.
13 Then I heard a holy one speaking; and another holy one said to that certain one who spoke, "How long will the vision about the continual burnt offering, and the disobedience that makes desolate, to give both the sanctuary and the army to be trodden under foot be?"
14 He said to me, "To two thousand and three hundred evenings and mornings. Then the sanctuary will be cleansed."
15 When I, even I Daniel, had seen the vision, I sought to understand it. Then behold, there stood before me something like the appearance of a man.
16 I heard a man's voice between the banks of the Ulai, which called, and said, "Gabriel, make this man understand the vision."
17 So he came near where I stood; and when he came, I was frightened, and fell on my face; but he said to me, "Understand, son of man; for the vision belongs to the time of the end."
18 Now as he was speaking with me, I fell into a deep sleep with my face toward the ground; but he touched me, and set me upright.
19 He said, "Behold, I will make you know what will be in the latter time of the indignation; for it belongs to the appointed time of the end.
20 The ram which you saw, that had the two horns, they are the kings of Media and Persia.
21 The rough male goat is the king of Greece. The great horn that is between his eyes is the first king.
22 As for that which was broken, in the place where four stood up, four kingdoms will stand up out of the nation, but not with his power.
23 "In the latter time of their kingdom, when the transgressors have come to the full, a king of fierce face, and understanding dark sentences, will stand up.
24 His power will be mighty, but not by his own power. He will destroy awesomely, and will prosper in what he does. He will destroy the mighty ones and the holy people.
25 Through his policy he will cause deceit to prosper in his hand. He will magnify himself in his heart, and he will

destroy many in their security. He will also stand up against the prince of princes; but he will be broken without human power.

26 "The vision of the evenings and mornings which has been told is true; but seal up the vision, for it belongs to many days to come."

27 I, Daniel, fainted, and was sick for some days. Then I rose up, and did the king's business. I wondered at the vision, but no one understood it.

9

1 In the first year of Darius the son of Ahasuerus, of the offspring of the Medes, who was made king over the realm of the Chaldeans,

2 in the first year of his reign I, Daniel, understood by the books the number of the years about which Yahweh's† word came to Jeremiah the prophet, for the accomplishing of the desolations of Jerusalem, even seventy years.

3 I set my face to the Lord God, to seek by prayer and petitions, with fasting in sackcloth and ashes.

4 I prayed to Yahweh my God, and made confession, and said,

"Oh, Lord, the great and dreadful God, who keeps covenant and loving kindness with those who love him and keep his commandments,

5 we have sinned, and have dealt perversely, and have done wickedly, and have rebelled, even turning aside from your precepts and from your ordinances.

6 We haven't listened to your servants the prophets, who spoke in your name to our kings, our princes, and our fathers, and to all the people of the land.

7 "Lord, righteousness belongs to you, but to us confusion of face, as it is today—to the men of Judah, and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem, and to all Israel, who are near, and who are far off, through all the countries where you have driven them, because of their trespass that they have trespassed against you.

8 Lord, to us belongs confusion of face, to our kings, to our princes, and to our fathers, because we have sinned against you.

9 To the Lord our God belong mercies and forgiveness; for we have rebelled against him.

10 We haven't obeyed Yahweh our God's voice, to walk in his laws, which he set before us by his servants the prophets.

11 Yes, all Israel have transgressed your law, turning aside, that they wouldn't obey your voice.

"Therefore the curse and the oath written in the law of Moses the servant of God has been poured out on us; for we have sinned against him.

12 He has confirmed his words, which he spoke against us, and against our judges who judged us, by bringing on us a great evil; for under the whole sky, such has not been done as has been done to Jerusalem.

13 As it is written in the law of Moses, all this evil has come on us. Yet we have not entreated the favor of Yahweh our God, that we should turn from our iniquities and have discernment in your truth.

14 Therefore Yahweh has watched over the evil, and brought it on us; for Yahweh our God is righteous in all his works which he does, and we have not obeyed his voice.

15 "Now, Lord our God, who has brought your people out of the land of Egypt with a mighty hand, and have gotten yourself renown, as it is today, we have sinned. We have done wickedly.

16 Lord, according to all your righteousness, please let your anger and your wrath be turned away from your city Jerusalem, your holy mountain, because for our sins, and for the iniquities of our fathers, Jerusalem and your people have become a reproach to all who are around us.

17 "Now therefore, our God, listen to the prayer of your servant, and to his petitions, and cause your face to shine

† **9:2** "Yahweh" is God's proper Name, sometimes rendered "LORD" (all caps) in other translations.

on your sanctuary that is desolate, for the Lord's sake.
18 My God, turn your ear and hear. Open your eyes and see our desolations and the city which is called by your name; for we don't present our petitions before you for our righteousness, but for your great mercies' sake.
19 Lord, hear. Lord, forgive. Lord, listen and do. Don't defer, for your own sake, my God, because your city and your people are called by your name."

20 While I was speaking, praying, and confessing my sin and the sin of my people Israel, and presenting my supplication before Yahweh my God for the holy mountain of my God—
21 yes, while I was speaking in prayer, the man Gabriel, whom I had seen in the vision at the beginning, being caused to fly swiftly, touched me about the time of the evening offering.
22 He instructed me and talked with me, and said, "Daniel, I have now come to give you wisdom and understanding.
23 At the beginning of your petitions the commandment went out and I have come to tell you, for you are greatly beloved. Therefore consider the matter and understand the vision.
24 "Seventy weeks are decreed on your people and on your holy city, to finish disobedience, to put an end to sin, to make reconciliation for iniquity, to bring in everlasting righteousness, to seal up vision and prophecy, and to anoint the most holy.
25 "Know therefore and discern that from the going out of the commandment to restore and to build Jerusalem to the Anointed One,‡ the prince, will be seven weeks and sixty-two weeks. It will be built again with street and moat, even in troubled times.
26 After the sixty-two weeks the Anointed One§ will be cut off and will have nothing. The people of the prince who come will destroy the city and the sanctuary. Its end will be with a flood, and war will be even to the end. Desolations are determined.
27 He will make a firm covenant with many for one week. In the middle of the week he will cause the sacrifice and the offering to cease. On the wing of abominations will come one who makes desolate. Even to the full end that is decreed, wrath will be poured out on the desolate."

10

1 In the third year of Cyrus king of Persia a revelation was revealed to Daniel, whose name was called Belteshazzar. The revelation was true, even a great warfare. He understood the revelation, and had understanding of the vision.
2 In those days I, Daniel, was mourning three whole weeks.
3 I ate no pleasant bread. No meat or wine came into my mouth. I didn't anoint myself at all, until three whole weeks were fulfilled.
4 In the twenty-fourth day of the first month, as I was by the side of the great river, which is Hiddekel,
5 I lifted up my eyes and looked, and behold, there was a man clothed in linen, whose thighs were adorned with pure gold of Uphaz.
6 His body also was like beryl, and his face like the appearance of lightning, and his eyes like flaming torches. His arms and his feet were like burnished bronze. The voice of his words was like the voice of a multitude.
7 I, Daniel, alone saw the vision; for the men who were with me didn't see the vision; but a great quaking fell on them, and they fled to hide themselves.
8 So I was left alone, and saw this great vision. No strength remained in me; for my face grew deathly pale, and I retained no strength.
9 Yet I heard the voice of his words. When I heard the voice of his words, then I fell into a deep sleep on my face, with my face toward the ground.

‡ **9:25** "Anointed One" can also be translated "Messiah" (same as "Christ").
§ **9:26** "Anointed One" can also be translated "Messiah" (same as "Christ").

10 Behold, a hand touched me, which set me on my knees and on the palms of my hands.
11 He said to me, “Daniel, you greatly beloved man, understand the words that I speak to you. Stand upright, for I have been sent to you, now.” When he had spoken this word to me, I stood trembling.
12 Then he said to me, “Don’t be afraid, Daniel; for from the first day that you set your heart to understand, and to humble yourself before your God, your words were heard. I have come for your words’ sake.
13 But the prince of the kingdom of Persia withstood me twenty-one days; but, behold, Michael, one of the chief princes, came to help me because I remained there with the kings of Persia.
14 Now I have come to make you understand what will happen to your people in the latter days; for the vision is yet for many days.”
15 When he had spoken these words to me, I set my face toward the ground, and was mute.
16 Behold, one in the likeness of the sons of men touched my lips. Then I opened my mouth, and spoke and said to him who stood before me, “My lord, by reason of the vision my sorrows have overtaken me, and I retain no strength.
17 For how can the servant of my lord talk with my lord? For as for me, immediately there remained no strength in me. There was no breath left in me.”
18 Then one like the appearance of a man touched me again, and he strengthened me.
19 He said, “Greatly beloved man, don’t be afraid. Peace be to you. Be strong. Yes, be strong.”
When he spoke to me, I was strengthened, and said, “Let my lord speak; for you have strengthened me.”
20 Then he said, “Do you know why I have come to you? Now I will return to fight with the prince of Persia. When I go out, behold, the prince of Greece will come.
21 But I will tell you what is inscribed in the writing of truth. There is no one who supports me against these except Michael, your prince.

11

1 “As for me, in the first year of Darius the Mede, I stood up to confirm and strengthen him.
2 “Now I will show you the truth. Behold, three more kings will stand up in Persia. The fourth will be far richer than all of them. When he has grown strong through his riches, he will stir up all against the realm of Greece.
3 A mighty king will stand up who will rule with great dominion, and do according to his will.
4 When he stands up, his kingdom will be broken, and will be divided toward the four winds of the sky, but not to his posterity, nor according to his dominion with which he ruled; for his kingdom will be plucked up, even for others besides these.
5 “The king of the south will be strong. One of his princes will become stronger than him and have dominion. His dominion will be a great dominion.
6 At the end of years they will join themselves together. The daughter of the king of the south will come to the king of the north to make an agreement, but she will not retain the strength of her arm. He will also not stand, nor will his arm; but she will be given up, with those who brought her and he who became her father, and he who strengthened her in those times.
7 “But out of a shoot from her roots one will stand up in his place who will come to the army and will enter into the fortress of the king of the north, and will deal against them and will prevail.
8 He will also carry their gods, with their molten images and their precious vessels of silver and of gold, captive into Egypt. He will refrain some years from the king of the north.
9 He will come into the realm of the king of the south, but he will return into his own land.
10 His sons will wage war and will assemble a multitude of great forces

which will keep coming and overflow and pass through. They will return and wage war, even to his fortress.

11 “The king of the south will be moved with anger and will come out and fight with him, even with the king of the north. He will send out a great multitude, and the multitude will be given into his hand.
12 The multitude will be lifted up, and his heart will be exalted. He will cast down tens of thousands, but he won’t prevail.
13 The king of the north will return, and will send out a multitude greater than the former. He will come on at the end of the times, even of years, with a great army and with abundant supplies.

14 “In those times many will stand up against the king of the south. Also the children of the violent among your people will lift themselves up to establish the vision; but they will fall.
15 So the king of the north will come and cast up a mound, and take a well-fortified city. The forces of the south won’t stand, neither will his chosen people, neither will there be any strength to stand.
16 But he who comes against him will do according to his own will, and no one will stand before him. He will stand in the glorious land, and destruction will be in his hand.
17 He will set his face to come with the strength of his whole kingdom, and with him equitable conditions. He will perform them. He will give him the daughter of women to corrupt her; but she will not stand, and won’t be for him.
18 After this he will turn his face to the islands, and will take many; but a prince will cause the reproach offered by him to cease. Yes, moreover, he will cause his reproach to turn on him.
19 Then he will turn his face toward the fortresses of his own land; but he will stumble and fall, and won’t be found.

20 “Then one who will cause a tax collector to pass through the kingdom to maintain its glory will stand up in his place; but within few days he shall be destroyed, not in anger, and not in battle.

21 “In his place, a contemptible person will stand up, to whom they had not given the honor of the kingdom; but he will come in time of security, and will obtain the kingdom by flatteries.
22 The overwhelming forces will be overwhelmed from before him, and will be broken. Yes, also the prince of the covenant.
23 After the treaty is made with him, he will work deceitfully; for he will come up, and will become strong with a small people.
24 In time of security, he will come even on the fattest places of the province. He will do that which his fathers have not done, nor his fathers’ fathers. He will scatter among them prey, plunder, and substance. Yes, he will devise his plans against the strongholds, even for a time.

25 “He will stir up his power and his courage against the king of the south with a great army; and the king of the south will wage war in battle with an exceedingly great and mighty army; but he won’t stand, for they will devise plans against him.
26 Yes, those who eat of his delicacies will destroy him, and his army will be swept away. Many will fall down slain.
27 As for both these kings, their hearts will be to do mischief, and they will speak lies at one table; but it won’t prosper, for the end will still be at the appointed time.
28 Then he will return into his land with great wealth. His heart will be against the holy covenant. He will take action and return to his own land.

29 “He will return at the appointed time and come into the south; but it won’t be in the latter time as it was in the former.
30 For ships of Kittim will come against him. Therefore he will be grieved, and will return, and have indignation against the holy covenant, and will take action. He will even return, and have regard to those who forsake the holy covenant.

31 “Forces will stand on his part and they will profane the sanctuary, even the fortress, and will take away the continual

burnt offering. Then they will set up the abomination that makes desolate.
32 He will corrupt those who do wickedly against the covenant by flatteries; but the people who know their God will be strong and take action.

33 “Those who are wise among the people will instruct many; yet they will fall by the sword and by flame, by captivity and by plunder, many days.
34 Now when they fall, they will be helped with a little help; but many will join themselves to them with flatteries.
35 Some of those who are wise will fall, to refine them, and to purify, and to make them white, even to the time of the end; because it is yet for the appointed time.

36 “The king will do according to his will. He will exalt himself, and magnify himself above every god, and will speak marvelous things against the God of gods. He will prosper until the indignation is accomplished; for what is determined will be done.
37 He won’t regard the gods of his fathers, or the desire of women, or regard any god; for he will magnify himself above all.
38 But in his place he will honor the god of fortresses. He will honor a god whom his fathers didn’t know with gold, silver, precious stones, and pleasant things.
39 He will deal with the strongest fortresses by the help of a foreign god. He will increase with glory whoever acknowledges him. He will cause them to rule over many, and will divide the land for a price.

40 “At the time of the end, the king of the south will contend with him; and the king of the north will come against him like a whirlwind, with chariots, with horsemen, and with many ships. He will enter into the countries, and will overflow and pass through.
41 He will enter also into the glorious land, and many countries will be overthrown; but these will be delivered out of his hand: Edom, Moab, and the chief of the children of Ammon.
42 He will also stretch out his hand against the countries. The land of Egypt won’t escape.
43 But he will have power over the treasures of gold and of silver, and over all the precious things of Egypt. The Libyans and the Ethiopians will be at his steps.
44 But news out of the east and out of the north will trouble him; and he will go out with great fury to destroy and utterly to sweep away many.
45 He will plant the tents of his palace between the sea and the glorious holy mountain; yet he will come to his end, and no one will help him.

12

1 “At that time Michael will stand up, the great prince who stands for the children of your people. There will be a time of trouble, such as never was since there was a nation even to that same time. At that time, your people will be delivered—everyone who is found written in the book.
2 Many of those who sleep in the dust of the earth will awake, some to everlasting life, and some to shame and everlasting contempt.
3 Those who are wise will shine as the brightness of the expanse. Those who turn many to righteousness will shine like the stars forever and ever.
4 But you, Daniel, shut up the words and seal the book, even to the time of the end. Many will run back and forth, and knowledge will be increased.”

5 Then I, Daniel, looked, and behold, two others stood, one on the river bank on this side, and the other on the river bank on that side.
6 One said to the man clothed in linen, who was above the waters of the river, “How long will it be to the end of these wonders?”
7 I heard the man clothed in linen, who was above the waters of the river, when he held up his right hand and his left hand to heaven, and swore by him who lives forever that it will be for a time, times, and a half; and when they have finished breaking in pieces the power of the holy people, all these things will be finished.

8 I heard, but I didn't understand. Then I
said, "My lord, what will be the outcome
of these things?"
9 He said, "Go your way, Daniel; for the
words are shut up and sealed until the
time of the end.
10 Many will purify themselves, make
themselves white, and be refined; but the
wicked will do wickedly. None of the
wicked will understand; but those who
are wise will understand.
11 "From the time that the continual
burnt offering is taken away and the
abomination that makes desolate set up,
there will be one thousand two hundred
ninety days.
12 Blessed is he who waits and comes to
the one thousand three hundred
thirty-five days.
13 "But go your way until the end; for
you will rest and will stand in your
inheritance at the end of the days."

13

THE HISTORY OF SUSANNA

1 †A man lived in Babylon, and his name
was Joakim.
2 He took a wife, whose name was
Susanna, the daughter of Helkias, a very
fair woman, and one who feared the Lord.
3 Her parents were also righteous, and
taught their daughter according to the
law of Moses.
4 Now Joakim was a great rich man, and
had a beautiful garden next to his house.
The Jews used to come to him, because he
was more honorable than all others.
5 The same year, two of the elders of the
people were appointed to be judges, such
as the Lord spoke of, that wickedness
came from Babylon from elders who were
judges, who were supposed to govern the
people.
6 These were often at Joakim's house.
All that had any lawsuits came to them.
7 When the people departed away at
noon, Susanna went into her husband's
garden to walk.
8 The two elders saw her going in every
day and walking; and they were inflamed
with lust for her.
9 They perverted their own mind and
turned away their eyes, that they might
not look to heaven, nor remember just
judgments.
10 And although they both were
wounded with lust for her, yet dared not
show the other his grief.
11 For they were ashamed to declare
their lust, what they desired to do with
her.
12 Yet they watched eagerly from day to
day to see her.
13 The one said to the other, "Let's go
home, now; for it is dinner time."
14 So when they had gone out, they
parted company, and turning back again,
they came to the same place. After they
had asked one another the cause, they
acknowledged their lust. Then they
appointed a time both together, when
they might find her alone.
15 It happened, as they watched on an
opportune day, she went in as before with
only two maids, and she desired to wash
herself in the garden; for it was hot.
16 There was nobody there except the
two elders who had hid themselves and
watched her.
17 Then she said to her maids, "Bring me
olive oil and ointment, and shut the
garden doors, that I may wash myself."
18 They did as she asked them and shut
the garden doors, and went out
themselves at the side doors to fetch the
things that she had commanded them.
They didn't see the elders, because they
were hidden.
19 Now when the maids had gone out,
the two elders rose up and ran to her,
saying,
20 "Behold, the garden doors are shut,
that no man can see us, and we are in love
with you. Therefore consent to us, and lie
with us.

† **13:1** *The History of Susanna* is translated from chapter 13 of *Daniel* in the Greek Septuagint. It is not found in the traditional Hebrew text of *Daniel*. *The History of Susanna* is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches.

21 If you will not, we will testify against
you, that a young man was with you;
therefore you sent your maids away from
you."
22 Then Susanna sighed, and said, "I am
trapped; for if I do this thing, it is death to
me. If I don't do it, I can't escape your
hands.
23 It is better for me to fall into your
hands, and not do it, than to sin in the
sight of the Lord."
24 With that Susanna cried with a loud
voice; and the two elders cried out against
her.
25 Then one of them ran and opened the
garden doors.
26 So when the servants of the house
heard the cry in the garden, they rushed
in at the side door to see what had
happened to her.
27 But when the elders had told their
tale, the servants were greatly ashamed;
for there was never such a report made of
Susanna.
28 It came to pass on the next day, when
the people assembled to her husband
Joakim, the two elders came full of their
wicked intent against Susanna to put her
to death,
29 and said before the people, "Send for
Susanna, the daughter of Helkias,
Joakim's wife." So they sent;
30 and she came with her father and
mother, her children, and all her kindred.
31 Now Susanna was a very delicate
woman, and beautiful to behold.
32 These wicked men commanded her to
be unveiled, for she was veiled, that they
might be filled with her beauty.
33 Therefore her friends and all who
saw her wept.
34 Then the two elders stood up in the
midst of the people and laid their hands
upon her head.
35 She, weeping, looked up toward
heaven; for her heart trusted in the Lord.
36 The elders said, "As we walked in the
garden alone, this woman came in with
two maids, shut the garden doors, and
sent the maids away.
37 Then a young man who was hidden
there came to her and lay with her.
38 And we, being in a corner of the
garden, saw this wickedness and ran to
them.
39 And when we saw them together, we
couldn't hold the man; for he was
stronger than we, and opened the doors,
and leaped out.
40 But having taken this woman, we
asked who the young man was, but she
would not tell us. We testify these things.
41 Then the assembly believed them, as
those who were elders of the people and
judges; so they condemned her to death.
42 Then Susanna cried out with a loud
voice, and said, "O everlasting God, you
know the secrets, and know all things
before they happen.
43 You know that they have testified
falsely against me. Behold, I must die,
even though I never did such things as
these men have maliciously invented
against me."
44 The Lord heard her voice.
45 Therefore when she was led away to
be put to death, God raised up the holy
spirit of a young youth, whose name was
Daniel.
46 He cried with a loud voice, "I am clear
from the blood of this woman!"
47 Then all the people turned them
toward him, and said, "What do these
words that you have spoken mean?"
48 So he, standing in the midst of them,
said, "Are you all such fools, you sons of
Israel, that without examination or
knowledge of the truth you have
condemned a daughter of Israel?
49 Return again to the place of
judgment; for these have testified falsely
against her."
50 Therefore all the people turned again
in haste, and the elders said to him,
"Come, sit down among us, and show it to
us, seeing God has given you the honor of
an elder."
51 Then Daniel said to them, "Put them
far apart from each another, and I will
examine them."
52 So when they were put apart one
from another, he called one of them, and
said to him, "O you who have become old
in wickedness, now your sins have

returned which you have committed before,
53 in pronouncing unjust judgment, condemning the innocent, and letting the guilty go free; although the Lord says, 'You shall not kill the innocent and righteous.'
54 Now then, if you saw her, tell me, under which tree did you see them companying together?"
He answered, "Under a mastick tree."
55 And Daniel said, "You have certainly lied against your own head; for even now the angel of God has received the sentence of God and will cut you in two."
56 So he put him aside, and commanded to bring the other, and said to him, "O you seed of Canaan, and not of Judah, beauty has deceived you, and lust has perverted your heart.
57 Thus you have dealt with the daughters of Israel, and they for fear were intimate with you; but the daughter of Judah would not tolerate your wickedness.
58 Now therefore tell me, under which tree did you take them being intimate together?"
He answered, "Under an evergreen oak tree."
59 Then Daniel said to him, "You have also certainly lied against your own head; for the angel of God waits with the sword to cut you in two, that he may destroy you."
60 With that, all the assembly cried out with a loud voice, and blessed God, who saves those who hope in him.
61 Then they arose against the two elders, for Daniel had convicted them of false testimony out of their own mouth.
62 According to the law of Moses they did to them what they maliciously intended to do to their neighbor. They put them to death, and the innocent blood was saved the same day.
63 Therefore Helkias and his wife praised God for their daughter Susanna, with Joakim her husband, and all the kindred, because there was no dishonesty found in her.
64 And from that day forth, Daniel had a great reputation in the sight of the people.

14

Bel and the Dragon

1 †King Astyages was gathered to his fathers, and Cyrus the Persian received his kingdom.
2 Daniel lived with the king, and was honored above all his friends.
3 Now the Babylonians had an idol called Bel, and every day twelve great measures of fine flour, forty sheep, and six firkins‡ of wine were spent on it.
4 The king honored it and went daily to worship it; but Daniel worshiped his own God. The king said to him, "Why don't you worship Bel?"
5 He said, "Because I may not honor idols made with hands, but only the living God, who has created the sky and the earth, and has sovereignty over all flesh."
6 Then the king said to him, "Don't you think that Bel is a living god? Don't you see how much he eats and drinks every day?"
7 Then Daniel laughed, and said, "O king, don't be deceived; for this is just clay inside, and brass outside, and never ate or drank anything."
8 So the king was angry, and called for his priests, and said to them, "If you don't tell me who this is who devours these expenses, you shall die.
9 But if you can show me that Bel devours them, then Daniel shall die; for he has spoken blasphemy against Bel."
Daniel said to the king, "Let it be according to your word."
10 Now there were seventy priests of Bel, besides their wives and children. The king went with Daniel into Bel's temple.
11 So Bel's priests said, "Behold, we will leave; but you, O king, set out the food, and mix the wine and set it out, shut the

† **14:1** *Bel and the Dragon* is translated from chapter 14 of *Daniel* in the Greek Septuagint. It is not found in the traditional Hebrew text of *Daniel*. *Bel and the Dragon* is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches. ‡ **14:3** a firkin is about 41 liters or 11 gallons.

door securely, and seal it with your own signet.
12 When you come in the morning, if you don't find that Bel has eaten everything, we will suffer death, or else Daniel, who speaks falsely against us."
13 They weren't concerned, for under the table they had made a secret entrance, by which they entered in continually, and consumed those things.
14 It happened, when they had gone out, the king set the food before Bel. Now Daniel had commanded his servants to bring ashes, and they scattered them all over the temple in the presence of the king alone. Then they went out, shut the door, sealed it with the king's signet, and so departed.
15 Now in the night, the priests came with their wives and children, as they usually did, and ate and drank it all.
16 In the morning, the king arose, and Daniel with him.
17 The king said, "Daniel, are the seals whole?"
He said, "Yes, O king, they are whole."
18 And as soon as he had opened the door, the king looked at the table, and cried with a loud voice, "You are great, O Bel, and with you is no deceit at all!"
19 Then Daniel laughed, and held the king that he should not go in, and said, "Behold now the pavement, and mark well whose footsteps these are."
20 The king said, "I see the footsteps of men, women, and children." Then the king was angry,
21 and took the priests with their wives and children, who showed him the secret doors, where they came in and consumed the things that were on the table.
22 Therefore the king killed them, and delivered Bel into Daniel's power, who overthrew it and its temple.
23 In that same place there was a great dragon which the people of Babylon worshiped.
24 The king said to Daniel, "Will you also say that this is of brass? Behold, he lives, eats and drinks. You can't say that he is no living god. Therefore worship him."
25 Then Daniel said, "I will worship the Lord my God; for he is a living God.
26 But allow me, O king, and I will kill this dragon without sword or staff."
The king said, "I allow you."
27 Then Daniel took pitch, fat, and hair, and melted them together, and made lumps of them. He put these in the dragon's mouth, so the dragon ate and burst apart. Daniel said, "Behold, these are the gods you all worship."
28 When the people of Babylon heard that, they took great indignation, and conspired against the king, saying, "The king has become a Jew. He has pulled down Bel, slain the dragon, and put the priests to the sword."
29 So they came to the king, and said, "Deliver Daniel to us, or else we will destroy you and your house."
30 Now when the king saw that they trapped him, being constrained, the king delivered Daniel to them.
31 They cast him into the lion's den, where he was six days.
32 There were seven lions in the den, and they had been giving them two carcasses and two sheep every day, which then were not given to them, intending that they would devour Daniel.
33 Now there was in Jewry the prophet Habakkuk,§ who had made stew, and had broken bread into a bowl. He was going into the field to bring it to the reapers.
34 But the angel of the Lord said to Habakkuk, "Go carry the dinner that you have into Babylon to Daniel, in the lions' den."
35 Habakkuk said, "Lord, I never saw Babylon. I don't know where the den is."
36 Then the angel of the Lord took him by the crown, and lifted him up by the hair of his head, and with the blast of his breath set him in Babylon over the den.
37 Habakkuk cried, saying, "O Daniel, Daniel, take the dinner which God has sent you."

§ **14:33** Gr. *Ambakoum.*

38 Daniel said, “You have remembered
me, O God! You haven’t forsaken those
who love you!”
39 So Daniel arose and ate; and the angel
of God set Habakkuk in his own place
again immediately.
40 On the seventh day, the king came to
mourn for Daniel. When he came to the
den, he looked in, and, behold, Daniel was
sitting.
41 Then the king cried with a loud voice,
saying, “Great are you, O Lord, you God of
Daniel, and there is none other beside
you!”
42 So he drew him out, and cast those
that were the cause of his destruction into
the den; and they were devoured in a
moment before his face.

The Wisdom of Solomon

The *Wisdom of Solomon* is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches.

1

1 Love righteousness, all you who are
judges of the earth.
Think of the Lord† with a good mind.
Seek him in singleness of heart,
2 because he is found by those who
don't put him to the test,
and is manifested to those who trust
him.
3 for crooked thoughts separate from God.
His Power convicts when it is tested,
and exposes the foolish;
4 because wisdom will not enter into a
soul that devises evil,
nor dwell in a body that is enslaved
by sin.
5 For a holy spirit of discipline will flee
deceit,
and will depart from thoughts that
are without understanding,
and will be ashamed when
unrighteousness has come in.

6 For‡ wisdom is a spirit who loves man,
and she will not hold a§ blasphemer
guiltless for his lips,
because God is witness of his inmost
self,
and is a true overseer of his heart,
and a hearer of his tongue.
7 Because the spirit of the Lord has filled†
the world,
and that which holds all things
together knows what is said.
8 Therefore no one who utters
unrighteous things will be unseen;
neither will Justice, when it convicts,
pass him by.
9 For in his counsels the ungodly will be
searched out,
and the sound of his words will come
to the Lord to bring his lawless
deeds to conviction;
10 because a jealous ear listens to all
things,
and the noise of murmurings is not
hidden.
11 Beware then of unprofitable
murmuring,
and keep your tongue from slander;
because no secret utterance will go on
its way void,
and a lying mouth destroys a soul.
12 Don't court death in the error of your
life.
Don't draw destruction upon
yourselves by the works of your
hands;
13 because God didn't make death,
neither does he delight when the
living perish.
14 For he created all things that they might
have being.
The generative powers of the world
are wholesome,
and there is no poison of destruction
in them,
nor has Hades‡ royal dominion upon
earth;
15 for righteousness is immortal,
16 but ungodly men by their hands
and their words summon death;
deeming him a friend they§ pined
away.
They made a covenant with him,
because they are worthy to belong
with him.

2

1 For they said† within themselves, with
unsound reasoning,
"Our life is short and sorrowful.
There is no healing when a man
comes to his end,
and no one was ever known who‡
was released from Hades.
2 Because we were born by mere chance,
and hereafter we will be as though
we had never been,

† **1:1** Gr. *in goodness.* ‡ **1:6** Some authorities read *the spirit of wisdom is loving to man.* § **1:6** Or, *reviler* † **1:7** Gr. *the inhabited earth.* ‡ **1:14** Or, *a royal house* § **1:16** Or, *were consumed* with love of him † **2:1** Or, *among* ‡ **2:1** Or, *returned out of Hades*

because the breath in our nostrils is smoke,
and reason is a spark kindled by the beating of our heart,
3 which being extinguished, the body will be turned into ashes,
and the spirit will be dispersed as thin air.
4 Our name will be forgotten in time.
No one will remember our works.
Our life will pass away as the traces of a cloud,
and will be scattered as is a mist,
when it is chased by the rays of the sun,
and§ overcome by its heat.
5 For our allotted time is the passing of a shadow,
and our end doesn't retreat,
because it is securely sealed, and no one† turns it back.

6 "Come therefore and let's enjoy the good things that exist.
Let's use the creation earnestly as in our youth.
7 Let's fill ourselves with costly wine and perfumes,
and let no spring flower pass us by.
8 Let's crown ourselves with rosebuds before they wither.
9 Let none of us go without his share in our proud revelry.
Let's leave tokens of mirth everywhere,
because this is our portion, and this is our lot.
10 Let's oppress the righteous poor.
Let's not spare the widow,
nor regard the gray hair of the old man.
11 But let our strength be a law of righteousness;
for that which is weak is proven useless.
12 But let's lie in wait for the righteous man,
because he annoys us,
is contrary to our works,
reproaches us with sins against the law,
and charges us with sins against our training.
13 He professes to have knowledge of God,
and calls himself a child of the Lord.
14 He became to us a reproof of our thoughts.
15 He is grievous to us even to look at,
because his life is unlike other men's,
and his paths are strange.
16 We were regarded by him as something worthless,
and he abstains from our ways as from uncleanness.
He calls the latter end of the righteous happy.
He boasts that God is his father.
17 Let's see if his words are true.
Let's test what will happen at the end of his life.
18 For if the righteous man is God's son, he will uphold him,
and he will deliver him out of the hand of his adversaries.
19 Let's test him with insult and torture,
that we may find out how gentle he is,
and test his patience.
20 Let's condemn him to a shameful death,
for he will be protected, according to his words."

21 Thus they reasoned, and they were led astray;
for their wickedness blinded them,
22 and they didn't know the mysteries of God,
neither did they hope for wages of holiness,
nor did they discern that there is a prize for blameless souls.
23 Because God created man for incorruption,
and made him an image of his own everlastingness;
24 but death entered into the world by the envy of the devil,
and those who belong to him experience it.

3

1 But the souls of the righteous are in the hand of God,
and no torment will touch them.

§ **2:4** Gr. *weighed down.* † **2:5** Or, *comes again*

2 In the eyes of the foolish they seemed to have died.
Their departure was considered a disaster,
3 and their travel away from us ruin,
but they are in peace.
4 For even if in the sight of men they are punished,
their hope is full of immortality.
5 Having borne a little chastening, they will receive great good;
because God tested them, and found them worthy of himself.
6 He tested them like gold in the furnace,
and he accepted them as a whole burnt offering.
7 In the time of their visitation they will shine.
They will run back and forth like sparks among stubble.
8 They will judge nations and have dominion over peoples.
The Lord will reign over them forever.
9 Those who trust him will understand truth.
The faithful will live with him in love,
because grace and mercy are with his chosen ones.

10 But the ungodly will be punished even as their reasoning deserves,
those who neglected righteousness and revolted from the Lord;
11 for he who despises wisdom and discipline is miserable.
Their hope is void and their toils unprofitable.
Their works are useless.
12 Their wives are foolish and their children are wicked.
13 Their descendants are cursed.
For the barren woman who is undefiled is happy,
she who has not conceived in transgression.
She will have fruit when God examines souls.
14 So is the eunuch which has done no lawless deed with his hands,
nor imagined wicked things against the Lord;
for a precious gift will be given to him for his faithfulness,
and a delightful inheritance in the Lord's sanctuary.
15 For good labors have fruit of great renown.
The root of understanding can't fail.
16 But children of adulterers will not come to maturity.
The seed of an unlawful union will vanish away.
17 For if they live long, they will not be esteemed,
and in the end, their old age will be without honor.
18 If they die young, they will have no hope,
nor consolation in the day of judgment.
19 For the end of an unrighteous generation is always grievous.

4

1 It is better to be childless with virtue,
for immortality is in the memory of virtue,
because it is recognized both before God and before men.
2 When it is present, people imitate it.
They long after it when it has departed.
Throughout all time it marches, crowned in triumph,
victorious in the competition for the prizes that are undefiled.
3 But the multiplying brood of the ungodly will be of no profit,
and their illegitimate offshoots won't take deep root,
nor will they establish a sure hold.
4 For even if they grow branches and flourish for a season,
standing unsure, they will be shaken by the wind.
They will be uprooted by the violence of winds.
5 Their branches will be broken off before they come to maturity.
Their fruit will be useless,
never ripe to eat, and fit for nothing.
6 For unlawfully conceived children are witnesses of wickedness

against parents when they are
investigated.

7 But a righteous man, even if he dies
before his time, will be at rest.
8 For honorable old age is not that which
stands in length of time,
nor is its measure given by number of
years,
9 but understanding is gray hair to
men,
and an unspotted life is ripe old age.

10 Being found well-pleasing to God,
someone was loved.
While living among sinners he was
transported.
11 He was caught away, lest evil should
change his understanding,
or guile deceive his soul.
12 For the fascination of wickedness
obscures the things which are good,
and the whirl of desire perverts an
innocent mind.
13 Being made perfect quickly,
he filled a long time;
14 for his soul was pleasing to the
Lord.
Therefore he hurried out of the midst
of wickedness.
15 But the peoples saw and didn't
understand,
not considering this, that grace and
mercy are with his chosen,
and that he visits his holy ones;
16 but a righteous man who is dead will
condemn the ungodly who are
living,
and youth who is quickly perfected
will condemn the many years of an
unrighteous man's old age.
17 For the ungodly will see a wise man's
end,
and won't understand what the Lord
planned for him,
and why he safely kept him.
18 They will see, and they will despise;
but the Lord will laugh them to scorn.
After this, they will become a dishonored
carcass
and a reproach among the dead
forever;

19 because he will dash them speechless to
the ground,
and will shake them from the
foundations.
They will lie utterly waste.
They will be in anguish
and their memory will perish.

20 They will come with coward fear when
their sins are counted.
Their lawless deeds will convict them
to their face.

5

1 Then the righteous man will stand in
great boldness
before the face of those who afflicted
him,
and those who make his labors of no
account.
2 When they see him, they will be troubled
with terrible fear,
and will be amazed at the marvel of
salvation.
3 They will speak among themselves
repenting,
and for distress of spirit they will
groan,
"This was he whom we used to hold in
derision,
as a parable of reproach.
4 We fools considered his life madness,
and his end without honor.
5 How was he counted among sons of God?
How is his lot among saints?
6 Truly we went astray from the way of
truth.
The light of righteousness didn't
shine for us.
The sun didn't rise for us.
7 We† took our fill of the paths of
lawlessness and destruction.
We traveled through trackless
deserts,
but we didn't know the Lord's way.
8 What did our arrogance profit us?
What good have riches and boasting
brought us?

9 Those things all passed away as a
shadow,
like a rumor that runs by,

† **5:7** See Proverbs 14:14.

10 like a ship passing through the billowy water,
which, when it has gone by, there is no trace to be found,
no pathway of its keel in the waves.
11 Or it is like when a bird flies through the air,
no evidence of its passage is found,
but the light wind, lashed with the stroke of its pinions,
and torn apart with the violent rush of the moving wings, is passed through.
Afterwards no sign of its coming remains.
12 Or it is like when an arrow is shot at a mark,
the air it divided closes up again immediately,
so that men don't know where it passed through.
13 So we also, as soon as we were born, ceased to be;
and we had no sign of virtue to show,
but we were utterly consumed in our wickedness."
14 Because the hope of the ungodly man is like chaff carried by the wind,
and‡ as§ foam vanishing before a tempest;
and is scattered like smoke by the wind,
and passes by as the remembrance of a guest who stays just a day.

15 But the righteous live forever.
Their reward is in the Lord,
and the care for them with the Most High.
16 Therefore they will receive the crown of royal dignity
and the diadem of beauty from the Lord's hand,
because he will cover them with his right hand,
and he will shield them with his arm.
17 He will take his zeal as complete armor,
and will make the whole creation his weapons to punish his enemies:
18 He will put on righteousness as a breastplate,
and will wear impartial judgment as a helmet.
19 He will take holiness as an invincible shield.
20 He will sharpen stern wrath for a sword.
The universe will go with him to fight against his frenzied foes.
21 Shafts of lightning will fly with true aim.
They will leap to the mark from the clouds, as from a well-drawn bow.
22 Hailstones full of wrath will be hurled as from a catapult.
The water of the sea will be angered against them.
Rivers will sternly overwhelm them.
23 A mighty wind will encounter them.
It will winnow them away like a tempest.
So lawlessness will make all the land desolate.
Their evil-doing will overturn the thrones of princes.

6

1 Hear therefore, you kings, and understand.
Learn, you judges of the ends of the earth.
2 Give ear, you rulers who have dominion over many people,
and make your boast† in multitudes of nations,
3 because your dominion was given to you from the Lord,
and your sovereignty from the Most High.
He will search out your works,
and will inquire about your plans,
4 because being officers of his kingdom,
you didn't judge rightly,
nor did you keep the law,
nor did you walk according to God's counsel.
5 He will come upon you awfully and swiftly,
because a stern judgment comes on those who are in high places.

‡ **5:14** Gr. *like foam chased to thinness:* or, *as thin foam chased.* § **5:14** Most Greek authorities read *hoar frost:* some authorities, perhaps rightly, *a spider's web.* † **6:2** Or, *in the multitudes of your nations*

6 For the man of low estate may be
pardoned in mercy,
but mighty men will be mightily
tested.
7 For the Sovereign Lord of all will not be
impressed with anyone,
neither will he show deference to
greatness;
because it is he who made both small and
great,
and cares about them all;
8 but the scrutiny that comes upon the
powerful is strict.
9 Therefore, my words are to you, O
princes,
that you may learn wisdom and not
fall away.
10 For those who have kept the things that
are holy in holiness will be made
holy.
Those who have been taught them
will find what to say in defense.
11 Therefore set your desire on my words.
Long for them, and you princes will
be instructed.

12 Wisdom is radiant and doesn't fade
away;
and is easily seen by those who love
her,
and found by those who seek her.
13 She anticipates those who desire her,
making herself known.
14 He who rises up early to seek her won't
have difficulty,
for he will find her sitting at his gates.
15 For to think upon her is perfection
of understanding,
and he who watches for her will
quickly be free from care;
16 because she herself goes around,
seeking those who are worthy of
her,
and in their paths she appears to
them graciously,
and in every purpose she meets them.
17 For her true beginning is desire for
instruction;
and desire for instruction is love.
18 And love is observance of her laws.
To give heed to her laws confirms
immortality.
19 Immortality brings closeness to God.
20 So then desire for wisdom
promotes to a kingdom.

21 If therefore you delight in thrones and
sceptres, you princes of peoples,
honor wisdom, that you may reign
forever.
22 But what wisdom is, and how she came
into being, I will declare.
I won't hide mysteries from you;
but I will explore from her first
beginning,
bring the knowledge of her into clear
light,
and I will not pass by the truth.
23 Indeed, I won't travel with consuming
envy,
because envy will have no fellowship
with wisdom.
24 But a multitude of wise men is salvation
to the world,
and an understanding king is stability
for his people.
25 Therefore be instructed by my words,
and you will profit.

7

1 I myself am also† mortal, like everyone
else,
and am a descendant of one formed
first and born of the earth.
2 I molded into flesh in the time of ten
months in my mother's womb,
being compacted in blood from the
seed of man and pleasure of
marriage.
3 I also, when I was born, drew in the
common air,
and fell upon the kindred earth,
uttering, like all, for my first voice, the
same cry.
4 I was nursed with care in swaddling
clothes.
5 For no king had a different beginning,
6 but all men have one entrance into
life, and a common departure.

7 For this cause I prayed, and
understanding was given to me.

† **7:1** Many authorities read *a mortal man.*

I asked, and a spirit of wisdom came
to me.
8 I preferred her before sceptres and
thrones.
I considered riches nothing in
comparison to her.
9 Neither did I liken to her any priceless
gem,
because all gold in her presence is a
little sand,
and silver will be considered as clay
before her.
10 I loved her more than health and
beauty,
and I chose to have her rather than
light,
because her bright shining is never
laid to sleep.
11 All good things came to me with her,
and innumerable riches are in her
hands.
12 And I rejoiced over them all because
wisdom leads them;
although I didn't know that she was
their mother.
13 As I learned without guile, I impart
without grudging.
I don't hide her riches.
14 For she is a treasure for men that
doesn't fail,
and those who use it obtain
friendship with God,
commended by the gifts which they
present through discipline.

15 But may God grant that I may speak his
judgment,
and to conceive thoughts worthy of
what has been given me;
because he is one who guides even
wisdom and who corrects the wise.
16 For both we and our words are in his
hand,
with all understanding and skill in
various crafts.
17 For he himself gave me an unerring
knowledge of the things that are,
to know the structure of the universe
and the operation of the elements;
18 the beginning, end, and middle of
times;
the alternations of the solstices and
the changes of seasons;
19 the circuits of years and the
positions of stars;
20 the natures of living creatures and
the raging of wild beasts;
the violence of‡ winds and the
thoughts of men;
the diversities of plants and the
virtues of roots.
21 All things that are either secret or
manifest I learned,
22 for wisdom, that is the architect of
all things, taught me.

For there is in her a spirit that is quick to
understand, holy,
unique, manifold, subtle, freely
moving, clear in utterance,
unpolluted,
distinct, invulnerable, loving what is
good, keen, unhindered,
23 beneficent, loving toward man,
steadfast, sure, free from care,
all-powerful, all-surveying,
and penetrating through all spirits
that are quick to understand, pure,
most subtle.
24 For wisdom is more mobile than any
motion.
Yes, she pervades and penetrates all
things by reason of her purity.
25 For she is a breath of the power of God,
and a pure emanation of the glory of
the Almighty.
Therefore nothing defiled can find
entrance into her.
26 For she is a reflection of everlasting
light,
an unspotted mirror of the working
of God,
and an image of his goodness.
27 Although she is one, she has power to
do all things.
Remaining in herself, she renews all
things.
From generation to generation passing
into holy souls,
she makes friends of God and
prophets.
28 For God loves nothing as much as
one who dwells with wisdom.
29 For she is fairer than the sun,

‡ **7:20** Or, *spirits*

and above all the constellations of the stars.
She is better than light.
30 For daylight yields to night,
but evil does not prevail against wisdom.

8

1 But she reaches from one end to the other with full strength,
and orders all things well.

2 I loved her and sought her from my youth.
I sought to take her for my bride.
I became enamoured by her beauty.
3 She glorifies her noble birth by living with God.
The Sovereign Lord of all loves her.
4 For she is initiated into the knowledge of God,
and she chooses his works.
5 But if riches are a desired possession in life,
what is richer than wisdom, which makes all things?
6 And if understanding is effective,
who more than† wisdom is an architect of the things that exist?
7 If a man loves righteousness,
the fruits of wisdom's labor‡ are virtues,
for she teaches soberness, understanding, righteousness, and courage.
There is nothing in life more profitable for people than these.
8 And if anyone longs for wide experience,
she knows the things of old, and infers the things to come.
She understands subtleties of speeches and interpretations of dark sayings.
She foresees signs and wonders, and the issues of seasons and times.

9 Therefore I determined to take her to live with me,
knowing that she is one who would give me good counsel,
and encourage me in cares and grief.
10 Because of her, I will have glory among multitudes,
and honor in the sight of elders, though I am young.
11 I will be found keen when I give judgment.
I will be admired in the presence of rulers.
12 When I am silent, they will wait for me.
When I open my lips, they will heed what I say.
If I continue speaking, they will put their hands on their mouths.
13 Because of her, I will have immortality,
and leave behind an eternal memory to those who come after me.
14 I will govern peoples.
Nations will be subjected to me.
15 Dreaded monarchs will fear me when they hear of me.
Among the people, I will show myself to be good, and courageous in war.
16 When I come into my house, I will find rest with her.
For conversation with her has no bitterness,
and living with her has no pain, but gladness and joy.
17 When I considered these things in myself,
and thought in my heart how immortality is in kinship to wisdom,
18 and in her friendship is good delight,
and in the labors of her hands is wealth that doesn't fail,
and understanding is in her companionship,
and great renown in having fellowship with her words,
I went about seeking how to take her to myself.
19 Now I was a clever child, and received a good soul.
20 Or rather, being good, I came into an undefiled body.
21 But perceiving that I could not otherwise possess wisdom unless God gave her to me—
yes, and to know and understand by whom the grace is given—

† **8:6** Gr. *she.* ‡ **8:7** Gr. *her labors*

I pleaded with the Lord and implored
him, and with my whole heart I
said:

9

1 "O God of my ancestors and Lord of
mercy,
who made all things by your word;
2 and by your wisdom you formed man,
that he should have dominion over
the creatures that were made by
you,
3 and rule the world in holiness and
righteousness,
and execute judgment in uprightness
of soul,
4 give me wisdom, her who sits by you
on your thrones.
Don't reject me from among your† servants,
5 because I am your servant and the
son of your handmaid,
a weak and short-lived man,
with little power to understand
judgment and laws.
6 For even if a man is perfect among the
sons of men,
if the wisdom that comes from you is
not with him, he will count for
nothing.
7 You chose me to be king of your people,
and a judge for your sons and
daughters.
8 You gave a command to build a
sanctuary on your holy mountain,
and‡ an altar in the city where you
live,
a copy of the holy tent which you
prepared from the beginning.
9 Wisdom is with you and knows your
works,
and was present when you were
making the world,
and understands what is pleasing in
your eyes,
and what is right according to your
commandments.
10 Send her from the holy heavens,
and ask her to come from the throne
of your glory,
that being present with me she may
work,
and I may learn what pleases you
well.
11 For she knows all things and
understands,
and she will guide me prudently in
my actions.
She will guard me in her glory.
12 So my works will be acceptible.
I will judge your people righteously,
and I will be worthy of my father's§
throne.
13 For what man will know the counsel of
God?
Or who will conceive what the Lord
wills?
14 For the thoughts of mortals are
unstable,
and our plans are prone to fail.
15 For a corruptible body weighs down the
soul.
The earthy tent burdens a mind that
is full of cares.
16 We can hardly guess the things that are
on earth,
and we find the things that are close
at hand with labor;
but who has traced out the things that
are in the heavens?
17 Who gained knowledge of your counsel,
unless you gave wisdom,
and sent your holy spirit from on
high?
18 It was thus that the ways of those who
are on earth were corrected,
and men were taught the things that
are pleasing to you.
They were saved through wisdom."

10

1 Wisdom† guarded to the end the first
formed father of the world, who
was created alone,
and delivered him out of his own
transgression,
2 and gave him strength to rule over all
things.
3 But when an unrighteous man fell away
from her in his anger,

† **9:4** Or, *children* ‡ **9:8** Or, *a place of sacrifice* § **9:12** Gr. *thrones.* † **10:1** Gr. *She.*

he perished himself in the rage with
which he killed his brother.
4 When for his cause the earth was
drowning with a flood,
wisdom again saved it,
guiding the righteous man's course by a
paltry piece of wood.

5 Moreover, when nations consenting
together in wickedness had been
confounded,
wisdom‡ knew the righteous man,
and preserved him blameless to
God,
and kept him strong when his heart
yearned toward his child.

6 While the ungodly were perishing,
wisdom§ delivered a righteous
man,
when he fled from the fire that
descended out of heaven on the five
cities.
7 To whose wickedness a smoking waste
still witnesses,
and plants bearing fair fruit that
doesn't ripen,
a disbelieving soul has a memorial: a
standing pillar of salt.
8 For having passed wisdom by,
not only were they disabled from
recognising the things which are
good,
but they also left behind them for
their life a monument of their folly,
to the end that where they stumbled,
they might fail even to be unseen;
9 but wisdom delivered those who waited
on her out of troubles.

10 When a righteous man was a fugitive
from a brother's wrath,† wisdom
guided him in straight paths.
She showed him God's kingdom, and
gave him knowledge of holy things.
She prospered him in his toils, and
multiplied the fruits of his labor.
11 When in their covetousness men dealt
harshly with him,
she stood by him and made him rich.
12 She guarded him from enemies,
and she kept him safe from those who
lay in wait.
Over his severe conflict, she watched
as judge,
that he might know that godliness is
more powerful than every one.

13 When a righteous man was sold,‡
wisdom didn't forsake him,
but she delivered him from sin.
She went down with him into a
dungeon,
14 and in bonds she didn't depart from
him,
until she brought him the sceptre of a
kingdom,
and authority over those that dealt
like a tyrant with him.
She also showed those who had
mockingly accused him to be false,
and gave him eternal glory.

15 Wisdom§ delivered a holy people and a
blameless seed from a nation of
oppressors.
16 She entered into the soul of a servant of
the Lord,
and withstood terrible kings in
wonders and signs.
17 She rendered to holy men a reward of
their toils.
She guided them along a marvelous
way,
and became to them a covering in the
day-time,
and a starry flame through the night.
18 She brought them over the Red sea,
and led them through much water;
19 but she drowned their enemies,
and she cast them up from the bottom
of the deep.
20 Therefore the righteous plundered the
ungodly,
and they sang praise to your holy
name, O Lord,
and extolled with one accord your
hand that fought for them,
21 because wisdom opened the mouth of
the mute,
and made the tongues of babes to speak
clearly.

‡ **10:5** Gr. *she* § **10:6** Gr. *she* † **10:10** Gr. *she.* ‡ **10:13** Gr. *she.* § **10:15** Gr. *she.*

11

1 Wisdom prospered their works in the
hand of a holy prophet.

2 They traveled through a desert without
inhabitant,
and they pitched their tents in
trackless regions.
3 They withstood enemies and repelled
foes.
4 They thirsted, and they called upon you,
and water was given to them out of
the† flinty rock,
and healing of their thirst out of the
hard stone.
5 For by what things their foes were
punished,
by these they in their need were
benefited.
6 When enemies were troubled with
clotted blood
instead of a river's ever-flowing
fountain,
7 to rebuke the decree for the slaying of
babies,
you gave them abundant water
beyond all hope,
8 having shown by the thirst which they
had suffered
how you punished the adversaries.
9 For when they were tried, although
chastened in mercy,
they learned how the ungodly were
tormented, being judged with
wrath.
10 For you tested these as a father
admonishing them;
but you searched out those as a stern
king condemning them.
11 Yes and whether they were far off or
near,
they were equally distressed;
12 for a double grief seized them,
and a groaning at the memory of
things past.
13 For when they heard that through their
own punishments the others
benefited,
they recognized the Lord.
14 For him who long before was thrown
out and exposed they stopped
mocking.
In the end of what happened, they
marveled,
having thirsted in another manner
than the righteous.

15 But in return for the senseless
imaginings of their
unrighteousness,
wherein they were led astray to
worship irrational reptiles and
wretched vermin,
you sent upon them a multitude of
irrational creatures to punish them,
16 that they might learn that by what
things a man sins, by these he is
punished.
17 For your all-powerful hand
that created the world out of formless
matter
didn't lack means to send upon them
a multitude of bears, fierce lions,
18 or newly-created and unknown
wild beasts, full of rage,
either breathing out a blast of fiery
breath,
or belching out smoke,
or flashing dreadful sparks from their
eyes;
19 which had power not only to consume
them by their violence,
but to destroy them even by the terror
of their sight.
20 Yes and without these they might have
fallen by a single breath,
being pursued by Justice, and
scattered abroad by the breath of
your power;
but you arranged all things by
measure, number, and weight.

21 For to be greatly strong is yours at all
times.
Who could withstand the might of
your arm?
22 Because the whole world before you is
as a grain in a balance,
and as a drop of dew that comes down
upon the earth in the morning.

† **11:4** See Deuteronomy 8:15; Psalms 114:8.

23 But you have mercy on all men, because
you have power to do all things,
and you overlook the sins of men to
the end that they may repent.
24 For you love all things that are,
and abhor none of the things which
you made;
For you never would have formed
anything if you hated it.
25 How would anything have endured
unless you had willed it?
Or that which was not called by you,
how would it have been preserved?
26 But you spare all things, because they
are yours,
O Sovereign Lord, you who love the
living.

12

1 For your incorruptible spirit is in all
things.
2 Therefore you convict little by little those
who fall from the right way,
and, putting them in remembrance
by the things wherein they sin, you
admonish them,
that escaping from their wickedness
they may believe in you, O Lord.

3 For truly the old inhabitants of your holy
land,
4 hating them because they practiced
detestable works of enchantments
and unholy rites—
5 merciless slaughters of children
and sacrificial banquets of men's
flesh and of blood—
6 allies in an impious fellowship,
and murderers of their own helpless
babes,
it was your counsel to destroy by the
hands of our fathers;
7 that the land which in your sight is
most precious of all
might receive a worthy colony of
God's servants.†
8 Nevertheless you even spared these as
men,
and you sent hornets‡ as forerunners
of your army,
to cause them to perish little by little.
9 Not that you were unable to subdue the
ungodly under the hand of the
righteous in battle,
or by terrible beasts or by a stern
word to make away with them at
once,
10 but judging them little by little you gave
them a chance to repent,
not being ignorant that their nature
by birth was evil,
their wickedness inborn,
and that their manner of thought
would never be changed.
11 For they were a cursed seed from the
beginning.
It wasn't through fear of any that you
left them unpunished for their sins.

12 For who will say, "What have you
done?"
Or "Who will withstand your
judgment?"
Who will accuse you for the perishing of
nations which you caused?
Or who will come and stand before
you as an avenger for unrighteous
men?
13 For there isn't any God beside you that
cares for all,
that you might show that you didn't
judge unrighteously.
14 No king or prince will be able to
confront you
about those whom you have
punished.
15 But being righteous, you rule all things
righteously,
deeming it a thing alien from your
power
to condemn one who doesn't deserve
to be punished.
16 For your strength is the source of
righteousness,
and your sovereignty over all makes
you to forbear all.
17 For when men don't believe that you
are perfect in power, you show
your strength,
and in dealing with those who think
this, you confuse their boldness.

† **12:7** Or, *children* ‡ **12:8** Or, *wasps*

18 But you, being sovereign in strength,
judge in gentleness,
and with great forbearance you
govern us;
for the power is yours whenever you
desire it.

19 But you taught your people by such
works as these,
how the righteous must be kind.
You made your sons to have good hope,
because you give repentance when
men have sinned.
20 For if on those who were enemies of
your servants§ and deserving of
death,
you took vengeance with so great
deliberation and indulgence,
giving them times and opportunities
when they might escape from their
wickedness,
21 with how great care you judged your
sons,
to whose fathers you gave oaths and
covenants of good promises!
22 Therefore while you chasten us, you
scourge our enemies ten thousand
times more,
to the intent that we may ponder your
goodness when we judge,
and when we are judged may look for
mercy.

23 Therefore also the unrighteous that
lived in a life of folly,
you tormented through their own
abominations.
24 For truly they went astray very far in
the ways of error,
Taking as gods those animals† which
even among their enemies were
held in dishonor,
deceived like foolish babes.
25 Therefore, as to unreasoning children,
you sent your judgment to mock
them.
26 But those who would not be
admonished by mild correction
will experience the deserved
judgment of God.
27 For through the sufferings they were
indignant of,
being punished in these creatures
which they supposed to be gods,
they saw and recognized as the true
God him whom they previously
refused to know.
Therefore also the result of extreme
condemnation came upon them.

13

1 For truly all men who had no perception
of God were foolish by nature,
and didn't gain power to know him
who exists from the good things
that are seen.
They didn't recognize the architect
from his works.
2 But they thought that either fire, or
wind, or swift air,
or circling stars, or raging water, or
luminaries of heaven
were gods that rule the world.
3 If it was through delight in their beauty
that they took them to be gods,
let them know how much better their
Sovereign Lord is than these,
for the first author of beauty created
them.
4 But if it was through astonishment at
their power and influence,
then let them understand from them
how much more powerful he who
formed them is.
5 For from the greatness of the beauty of
created things,
mankind forms the corresponding
perception of their Maker.†
6 But yet for these men there is but small
blame,
for they too perhaps go astray
while they are seeking God and
desiring to find him.
7 For they diligently search while living
among his works,
and they trust their sight that the
things that they look at are
beautiful.
8 But again even they are not to be
excused.

§ **12:20** Or, *children* † **12:24** Gr. *living creatures:* and so elsewhere in this book. † **13:5** Gr. *is the first maker of them seen.*

9 For if they had power to know so much,
that they should be able to explore the world,
how is it that they didn't find the Sovereign Lord sooner?

10 But they were miserable, and their hopes were in dead things,
who called them gods which are works of men's hands,
gold and silver, skillfully made, and likenesses of animals,
or a useless stone, the work of an ancient hand.
11 Yes and some‡ woodcutter might saw down a tree that is easily moved,
skillfully strip away all its bark,
and fashion it in attractive form,
make a useful vessel to serve his life's needs.
12 Burning the scraps from his handiwork to cook his food,
he eats his fill.
13 Taking a discarded scrap which served no purpose,
a crooked piece of wood and full of knots,
he carves it with the diligence of his idleness,
and shapes it by the skill of his idleness.
He shapes it in the image of a man,
14 or makes it like some worthless animal,
smearing it with something red, painting it red,
and smearing over every stain in it.
15 Having made a worthy chamber for it,
he sets it in a wall, securing it with iron.
16 He plans for it that it may not fall down,
knowing that it is unable to help itself
(for truly it is an image, and needs help).
17 When he makes his prayer concerning goods and his marriage and children,
he is not ashamed to speak to that which has no life.
18 Yes, for health, he calls upon that which is weak.
For life, he implores that which is dead.
For aid, he supplicates that which has no experience.
For a good journey, he asks that which can't so much as move a step.
19 And for profit in business and good success of his hands,
he asks ability from that which has hands with no ability.

14

1 Again, one preparing to sail, and about to journey over raging waves,
calls upon a piece of wood more fragile than the vessel that carries him.
2 For the hunger for profit planned it,
and wisdom was the craftsman who built it.
3 Your providence, O Father, guides it along,
because even in the sea you gave a way,
and in the waves a sure path,
4 showing that you can save out of every danger,
that even a man without skill may put to sea.
5 It is your will that the works of your wisdom should not be ineffective.
Therefore men also entrust their lives to a little piece of wood,
and passing through the surge on a raft come safely to land.
6 For† in the old time also, when proud giants were perishing,
the hope of the world, taking refuge on a raft,
your hand guided the seed of generations of the race of men.
7 For blessed is wood through which comes righteousness;
8 but the idol made with hands is accursed, itself and he that made it;
because his was the working, and the corruptible thing was called a god.
9 For both the ungodly and his ungodliness are alike hateful to God;

‡ **13:11** Gr. *carpenter who is a woodcutter.* † **14:6** The Greek text here may be corrupt.

10 for truly the deed will be punished
together with him who committed
it.
11 Therefore also there will be a
visitation among the idols of the
nation,
because, though formed of things
which God created, they were made
an abomination,
stumbling blocks to the souls of men,
and a snare to the feet of the foolish.

12 For the devising of idols was the
beginning of fornication,
and the invention of them the
corruption of life.
13 For they didn't exist from the beginning,
and they won't exist forever.
14 For by the boastfulness of men they
entered into the world,
and therefore a speedy end was
planned for them.

15 For a father worn with untimely grief,
making an image of the child quickly
taken away,
now honored him as a god which was
then a dead human being,
and delivered to those that were
under him mysteries and solemn
rites.
16 Afterward the ungodly custom, in
process of time grown strong, was
kept as a law,
and the engraved images received
worship by the commandments of
princes.
17 And when men could not honor them in
presence because they lived far off,
imagining the likeness from afar,
they made a visible image of the king
whom they honored,
that by their zeal they might flatter
the absent as if present.

18 But worship was raised to a yet higher
pitch, even by those who didn't
know him,
urged forward by the ambition of the
architect;
19 for he, wishing perhaps to please his
ruler,
used his art to force the likeness
toward a greater beauty.
20 So the multitude, allured by reason of
the grace of his handiwork,
now consider an object of devotion
him that a little before was honored
as a man.
21 And this became an ambush,
because men, in bondage either to
calamity or to tyranny,
invested stones and stocks with the
Name that shouldn't be shared.

22 Afterward it was not enough for them
to go astray concerning the
knowledge of God,
but also, while they live in a great war
of ignorance, they call a multitude
of evils peace.
23 For either slaughtering children in
solemn rites, or celebrating secret
mysteries,
or holding frenzied revels of strange
customs,
24 no longer do they guard either life or
purity of marriage,
but one brings upon another either
death by treachery, or anguish by
adultery.
25 And all things confusedly are filled with
blood and murder, theft and deceit,
corruption, faithlessness, tumult,
perjury,
26 confusion about what is good,
forgetfulness of favors,
ingratitude for benefits,
defiling of souls, confusion of sex,
disorder in marriage, adultery and
wantonness.
27 For the worship of idols that may
not be named*
is a beginning and cause and end of
every evil.
28 For their worshipers either make merry
to madness, or prophesy lies,
or live unrighteously, or lightly
commit perjury.
29 For putting their trust in lifeless idols,

* **14:27** Exodus 23:13; Psalms 16:4; Hosea 2:17; Wisdom 14:21

when they have sworn a wicked oath,
they expect not to suffer harm.
30 But on both counts, the just doom will
pursue them,
because they had evil thoughts of God
by giving heed to idols,
and swore unrighteously in deceit
through contempt for holiness.
31 For it is not the power of things by
which men swear,
but it is the just penalty for those who
sin
that always visits the transgression of
the unrighteous.

15

1 But you, our God, are gracious and true,
patient, and in mercy ordering all
things.
2 For even if we sin, we are yours,
knowing your dominion;
but we will not sin, knowing that we
have been accounted yours.
3 For to be acquainted with you is† perfect
righteousness,
and to know your dominion is the
root of immortality.
4 For we weren't led astray by any evil
plan of men's,
nor yet by painters' fruitless labor,
a form stained with varied colors,
5 the sight of which leads fools into‡ lust.
Their desire is for the breathless form
of a dead image.
6 Lovers of evil things, and worthy of such
hopes,
are those who make, desire, and
worship them.

7 For a potter, kneading soft earth,
laboriously molds each article for our
service.
He fashions out of the same clay
both the vessels that minister to clean
uses, and those of a contrary sort,
all in like manner.
What shall be the use of each article of
either sort,
the potter is the judge.
8 Also, laboring to an evil end, he molds a
vain god out of the same clay,
he who, having but a little before
been made of earth,
after a short space goes his way to the
earth out of which he was taken,
when he is required to give back the§
soul which was lent him.
9 However he has anxious care,
not because his powers must fail,
nor because his span of life is short;
But he compares himself with goldsmiths
and silversmiths,
and he imitates molders in† brass,
and considers it great that he molds
counterfeit gods.
10 His heart is ashes.
His hope is of less value than earth.
His life is of less honor than clay,
11 because he was ignorant of him who
molded him,
and of him that inspired into him‡ an
active§ soul,
and breathed into him a vital spirit.
12 But† he accounted our life to be a game,
and our‡ lifetime a festival for profit;
for, he says, one must get gain however
one can, even if it is by evil.
13 For this man, beyond all others, knows
that he sins,
out of earthy matter making brittle
vessels and engraved images.
14 But most foolish and more miserable
than a baby,
are the enemies of your people, who
oppressed them;
15 because they even considered all the
idols of the nations to be gods,
which have neither the use of eyes for
seeing,
nor nostrils for drawing breath,
nor ears to hear,
nor fingers for handling,
and their feet are helpless for
walking.
16 For a man made them,

† **15:3** Gr. *entire.* ‡ **15:5** Some authorities read *reproach.* § **15:8** Or, *life* † **15:9** Or, *copper* ‡ **15:11** Gr. *a soul that moves to activity.* § **15:11** Or, *life* † **15:12** Some authorities read *they accounted.* ‡ **15:12** Or, *way of life*

and one whose own spirit is
borrowed molded them;
for no one has power as a man to
mold a god like himself.
17 But, being mortal, he makes a dead
thing by the work of lawless hands;
for he is better than the objects of his
worship,
since he indeed had life, but they
never did.

18 Yes, and they worship the creatures that
are most hateful,
for, being compared as to lack of
sense, these are worse than all
others;
19 Neither, as seen beside other creatures,
are they beautiful, so that one
should desire them,
but they have escaped both the praise
of God and his blessing.

16

1 For this cause, they were deservedly
punished through creatures like
those which they worship,
and tormented through a multitude
of vermin.
2 Instead of this punishment, you, giving
benefits to your people,
prepared quails for food,
a delicacy to satisfy the desire of their
appetite,
3 to the end that your enemies, desiring
food,
might for the hideousness of the
creatures sent among them,
loathe even the necessary appetite;
but these, your people, having for a short
time suffered lack,
might even partake of delicacies.
4 For it was necessary that inescapable
lack should come upon those
oppressors,
but that to these it should only be
showed how their enemies were
tormented.
5 For even when terrible raging of wild
beasts came upon your people,
and they were perishing by the bites
of crooked serpents,
your wrath didn't continue to the
uttermost;
6 but for admonition were they troubled
for a short time,
having a token of salvation
to put them in remembrance of the
commandment of your law;

7 for he who turned toward it was not
saved because of that which was
seen,
but because of you, the Savior of all.
8 Yes, and in this you persuaded our
enemies
that you are he who delivers out of
every evil.
9 For the bites of locusts and flies truly
killed them.
No healing for their life was found,
because they were worthy to be
punished by such things.
10 But your children weren't overcome by
the very fangs of venomous
dragons,
for your mercy passed by where they
were and healed them.
11 For they were bitten to put them in
remembrance of your oracles,
and were quickly saved, lest, falling
into deep forgetfulness,
they should become unable to
respond to your kindness.
12 For truly it was neither herb nor
poultice that cured them,
but your word, O Lord, which heals
all people.
13 For you have authority over life and
death,
and you lead down to the gates of
Hades, and lead up again.
14 But though a man kills by his
wickedness,
he can't retrieve the spirit that has
departed
or release the imprisoned soul.

15 But it is not possible to escape your
hand;
16 for ungodly men, refusing to know you,
were scourged in the strength of
your arm,

pursued with strange rains and hails
and relentless storms,
and utterly consumed with fire.
17 For, what was most marvelous,
in the water which quenches all
things, the fire burned hotter;
for the world fights for the righteous.
18 For at one time the flame was
restrained,
that it might not burn up the
creatures sent against the ungodly,
but that these themselves as they
looked might see that they were
chased by the judgment of God.
19 At another time even in the midst of
water it burns more intensely than
fire,
that it may destroy the produce of an
unrighteous land.
20 Instead of these things, you gave your
people angels' food to eat,
and you provided ready-to-eat bread
for them from heaven without toil,
having the virtue of every pleasant
flavor,
and agreeable to every taste.
21 For your nature showed your sweetness
toward your children,
while that bread, serving the desire of
the eater,
changed itself according to every
man's choice.
22 But snow and ice endured fire, and
didn't melt,
that people might know that fire was
destroying the fruits of the enemies,
burning in the hail and flashing in the
rains;
23 and that this fire, again, in order that
righteous people may be nourished,
has even forgotten its own power.
24 For the creation, ministering to you, its
maker,
strains its force against the
unrighteous for punishment
and in kindness, slackens it on behalf
of those who trust in you.
25 Therefore at that time also, converting
itself into all forms,
it ministered to your all-nourishing
bounty,
according to the desire of those who
had need,
26 that your children, whom you loved, O
Lord, might learn
that it is not the growth of crops that
nourishes a man,
but that your word preserves those
who trust you.
27 For that which was not destroyed by
fire,
melted away when it was simply
warmed by a faint sunbeam,
28 that it might be known that we must rise
before the sun to give you thanks,
and must pray to you at the dawning
of the light;
29 for the hope of the unthankful will melt
as the winter's hoar frost,
and will flow away as water that has
no use.

17

1 For your judgments are great, and hard
to interpret;
therefore undisciplined souls went
astray.
2 For when lawless men had supposed
that they held a holy nation in their
power,
they, prisoners of darkness, and
bound in the fetters of a long night,
kept close beneath their roofs,
lay exiled from the eternal
providence.
3 For while they thought that they were
unseen in their secret sins,
they were divided from one another
by a dark curtain of forgetfulness,
stricken with terrible awe, and very
troubled by apparitions.
4 For neither did the dark recesses that
held them guard them from fears,
but terrifying sounds rang around
them,
and dismal phantoms appeared with
unsmiling faces.
5 And no power of fire prevailed to give
light,
neither were the brightest flames of
the stars strong enough to
illuminate that gloomy night;

6 but only the glimmering of a self-kindled
fire appeared to them, full of fear.
In terror, they considered the things
which they saw
to be worse than that sight, on which
they could not gaze.
7 The mockeries of their magic arts were
powerless, now,
and a shameful rebuke of their
boasted understanding:
8 For those who promised to drive away
terrors and disorders from a sick
soul,
these were sick with a ludicrous
fearfulness.
9 For even if no troubling thing frighted
them,
yet, scared with the creeping of
vermin and hissing of serpents,
10 they perished trembling in fear,
refusing even to look at the air, which
could not be escaped on any side.
11 For wickedness, condemned by a
witness within, is a coward thing,
and, being pressed hard by
conscience, always has added
forecasts of the worst.
12 For fear is nothing else but a
surrender of the help which reason
offers;
13 and from within, the expectation of
being less
prefers ignorance of the cause that
brings the torment.
14 But they, all through the night which
was powerless indeed,
and which came upon them out of the
recesses of powerless Hades,
sleeping the same sleep,
15 now were haunted by monstrous
apparitions,
and now were paralyzed by their
soul's surrendering;
for sudden and unexpected fear came
upon them.
16 So then whoever it might be, sinking
down in his place,
was kept captive, shut up in that
prison which was not barred with
iron;
17 for whether he was a farmer, or a
shepherd,
or a laborer whose toils were in the
wilderness,
he was overtaken, and endured that
inescapable sentence;
for they were all bound with one
chain of darkness.
18 Whether there was a whistling wind,
or a melodious sound of birds among
the spreading branches,
or a measured fall of water running
violently,
19 or a harsh crashing of rocks hurled
down,
or the swift course of animals
bounding along unseen,
or the voice of wild beasts harshly
roaring,
or an echo rebounding from the
hollows of the mountains,
all these things paralyzed them with
terror.
20 For the whole world was illuminated
with clear light,
and was occupied with unhindered
works,
21 while over them alone was spread a
heavy night,
an image of the darkness that should
afterward receive them;
but to themselves, they were heavier
than darkness.

18

1 But for your holy ones there was great
light.
Their enemies, hearing their voice
but not seeing their form,
counted it a happy thing that they too
had suffered,
2 yet for that they do not hurt them,
though wronged by them before,
they are thankful;
and because they had been at
variance with them, they begged
for pardon.
3 Therefore you provided a burning pillar
of fire,
to be a guide for your people's
unknown journey,

and a harmless sun for their glorious exile.
4 For the Egyptians well deserved to be deprived of light and imprisoned by darkness,
they who had imprisoned your children,
through whom the incorruptible light of the law was to be given to the race of men.

5 After they had taken counsel to kill the babes of the holy ones,
and when a single child had been abandoned and saved to convict them of their sin,
you took away from them their multitude of children,
and destroyed all their army together in a mighty flood.
6 Our fathers were made aware of that night beforehand,
that, having sure knowledge, they might be cheered by the oaths which they had trusted.
7 Salvation of the righteous and destruction of the enemies was expected by your people.
8 For as you took vengeance on the adversaries,
by the same means, calling us to yourself, you glorified us.
9 For holy children of good men offered sacrifice in secret,
and with one consent they agreed to the covenant of the divine law,
that they would partake alike in the same good things and the same perils,
the fathers already leading the sacred songs of praise.
10 But the discordant cry of the enemies echoed back,
and a pitiful voice of lamentation for children was spread abroad.
11 Both servant and master were punished with the same just doom,
and the commoner suffering the same as king;
12 Yes, they all together, under one form of death,
had corpses without number.
For the living were not sufficient even to bury them,
Since at a single stroke, their most cherished offspring was consumed.
13 For while they were disbelieving all things by reason of the enchantments,
upon the destruction of the firstborn they confessed the people to be God's children.
14 For while peaceful silence wrapped all things,
and night in her own swiftness was half spent,
15 your all-powerful word leaped from heaven, from the royal throne,
a stern warrior, into the midst of the doomed land,
16 bearing as a sharp sword your authentic commandment,
and standing, it filled all things with death,
and while it touched the sky it stood upon the earth.
17 Then immediately apparitions in dreams terribly troubled them,
and unexpected fears came upon them.
18 And each, one thrown here half dead, another there,
made known why he was dying;
19 for the dreams, disturbing them, forewarned them of this,
that they might not perish without knowing why they were afflicted.

20 The experience of death also touched the righteous,
and a multitude were destroyed in the wilderness,
but the wrath didn't last long.
21 For a blameless man hurried to be their champion,
bringing the weapon of his own ministry,
prayer, and the atoning sacrifice of incense.
He withstood the indignation and set an end to the calamity,
showing that he was your servant.
22 And he overcame the anger,

not by strength of body, not by force of weapons,
but by his word, he subdued the avenger
by bringing to remembrance oaths and covenants made with the fathers.
23 For when the dead had already fallen in heaps one upon another,
he intervened and stopped the wrath,
and cut off its way to the living.
24 For the whole world was pictured on his long robe,
and the glories of the fathers were upon the engraving of the four rows of precious stones,
and your majesty was upon the diadem on his head.
25 The destroyer yielded to these, and they feared;
for it was enough only to test the wrath.

19

1 But indignation without mercy came upon the ungodly to the end;
for God also foreknew their future,
2 how, having changed their minds to let your people go,
and having sped them eagerly on their way,
they would change their minds and pursue them.
3 For while they were yet in the midst of their mourning,
and lamenting at the graves of the dead,
they made another foolish decision,
and pursued as fugitives those whom they had begged to leave and driven out.
4 For the doom which they deserved was drawing them to this end,
and it made them forget the things that had happened to them,
that they might fill up the punishment which was yet lacking from their torments,
5 and that your people might journey on by a marvelous road,
but they themselves might find a strange death.

6 For the whole creation, each part in its diverse kind, was made new again,
complying with your commandments,
that your servants might be kept unharmed.
7 Then the cloud that overshadowed the camp was seen,
and dry land rising up out of what had been water,
out of the Red sea an unhindered highway,
and a grassy plain out of the violent surge,
8 by which they passed over with all their army,
these who were covered with your hand,
having seen strange marvels.
9 For like horses they roamed at large,
and they skipped about like lambs,
praising you, O Lord, who was their deliverer.
10 For they still remembered the things that happened in the time of their sojourning,
how instead of bearing cattle, the land brought forth lice,
and instead of fish, the river spewed out a multitude of frogs.
11 But afterwards, they also saw a new kind of birds,
when, led on by desire, they asked for luxurious dainties;
12 for, to comfort them, quails came up for them from the sea.

13 Punishments came upon the sinners,
not without the signs that were given beforehand by the violence of the thunder,
for they justly suffered through their own wickednesses,
for the hatred which they practiced toward guests was grievous indeed.
14 For while the others didn't receive the strangers when they came to them,
the Egyptians made slaves of guests who were their benefactors.

15 And not only so, but while punishment
of some sort will come upon the
former,
since they received as enemies those
who were aliens;
16 because these first welcomed with
feastings,
and then afflicted with dreadful toils,
those who had already shared with
them in the same rights.
17 And moreover they were stricken with
loss of sight
(even as were those others at the
righteous man's doors),
when, being surrounded with
yawning darkness,
they each looked for the passage
through his own door.

18 For as the notes of a lute vary the
character of the rhythm,
even so the elements, changing their
order one with another,
continuing always in its sound,
as may clearly be conjectured from
the sight of the things that have
happened.
19 For creatures of the dry land were
turned into creatures of the waters,
and creatures that swim moved upon
the land.
20 Fire kept the mastery of its own power
in water,
and water forgot its quenching
nature.
21 On the contrary, flames didn't consume
flesh of perishable creatures that
walked among them,
neither did they melt the crystalline
grains of ambrosial food that were
melted easily.

22 For in all things, O Lord, you magnified
your people,
and you glorified them and didn't
lightly regard them,
standing by their side in every time
and place.

The Wisdom of Jesus the Son of Sirach, or Ecclesiaticus

The Wisdom of Jesus the Son of Sirach, also called *Ecclesiasticus*, is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches.

The Prologue of the Wisdom of Jesus the Son of Sirach.

WHEREAS many and great things have been delivered to us by the law and the prophets, and by the others that have followed in their steps, for which we must give Israel the praise for instruction and wisdom; and since not only the readers need to become skillful themselves, but also those who love learning must be able to profit those who are outside, both by speaking and writing; my grandfather Jesus, having much given himself to the reading of the law, the prophets, and the other books of our fathers, and having gained great familiarity with them, was also drawn on himself to write somewhat pertaining to instruction and wisdom, in order that those who love learning, and are devoted to these things, might make progress much more by living according to the law. You are entreated therefore to read with favor and attention, and to pardon us, if in any parts of what we have labored to interpret, we may seem to fail in some of the phrases. For things originally spoken in Hebrew don't have the same force in them when they are translated into another language. Not only these, but the law itself, and the prophecies, and the rest of the books, have no small difference, when they are spoken in their original language. For having come into Egypt in the thirty-eighth year of Energetes the king, and having continued there some time, I found a copy giving no small instruction. I thought it therefore most necessary for me to apply some diligence and travail to translate this book, applying indeed much watchfulness and skill in that space of time to bring the book to an end and publish for them also, who in the land of their travels are desiring to learn, preparing their character in advance, so as to live according to the law.

1

1 All wisdom comes from the Lord,
and is with him forever.
2 Who can count the sand of the seas,
the drops of rain,
and the days of eternity?
3 Who will search out the height of the sky,
the breadth of the earth, the deep,
and wisdom?
4 Wisdom has been created before all things,
and the understanding of prudence from everlasting.
5 †
6 To whom has the root of wisdom been revealed?
Who has known her shrewd counsels?
7 ‡
8 There is one wise, greatly to be feared,
sitting upon his throne: the Lord.
9 He created her.
He saw and measured her.
He poured her out upon all his works.
10 She is with all flesh according to his gift.
He gave her freely to those who love him.

11 The fear of the Lord is glory, exultation,
gladness, and a crown of rejoicing.
12 The fear of the Lord will delight the heart,
and will give gladness, joy, and length of days.
13 Whoever fears the Lord, it will go well with him at the last.
He will be blessed in the day of his death.

† **1:5** Verse 5 is omitted by the best authorities: *The source of wisdom is God's word in the highest heaven, and her ways are the eternal commandments.* ‡ **1:7** Verse 7 is omitted by the best authorities: *To whom was the knowledge of wisdom manifested? Who has understood her abundant experience?*

14 To fear the Lord is the beginning of wisdom.
It was created together with the faithful in the womb.
15 She§ laid an eternal foundation with men.
She will be trusted among their offspring.
16 To fear the Lord is the fullness of wisdom.
She inebriates men with her fruits.
17 She will fill all her house with desirable things,
and her storehouses with her produce.
18 The fear of the Lord is the crown of wisdom,
making peace and† perfect health to flourish.‡
19 He both saw and measured her.
He rained down skill and knowledge of understanding,
and exalted the honor of those who hold her fast.
20 To fear the Lord is the root of wisdom.
Her branches are length of days.
21 §

22 Unjust wrath can never be justified,
for his wrath tips the scale to his downfall.
23 A man that is patient will resist for a season,
and afterward gladness will spring up to him.
24 He will hide his words until the right moment,
and the lips of many will tell of his understanding.

25 A wise saying is in the treasures of wisdom;
but godliness is an abomination to a sinner.
26 If you desire wisdom, keep the commandments
and the Lord will give her to you freely;
27 for the fear of the Lord is wisdom and instruction.
Faith and humility are his good pleasure.
28 Don't disobey the fear of the Lord.
Don't come to him with a double heart.
29 Don't be a hypocrite in men's sight.
Keep watch over your lips.
30 Don't exalt yourself,
lest you fall and bring dishonor upon your soul.
The Lord will reveal your secrets
and will cast you down in the midst of the congregation,
because you didn't come to the fear of the Lord
and your heart was full of deceit.

2

1 My son, if you come to serve the Lord,
prepare your soul for temptation.
2 Set your heart aright, constantly endure,
and don't make haste in time of calamity.
3 Cling to him, and don't depart,
that you may be increased at your latter end.
4 Accept whatever is brought upon you,
and be patient when you suffer humiliation.
5 For gold is tried in the fire,
and acceptable men in the furnace of humiliation.
6 Put your trust in him, and he will help you.
Make your ways straight, and set your hope on him.

7 All you who fear the Lord, wait for his mercy.
Don't turn aside, lest you fall.
8 All you who fear the Lord, put your trust in him,
and your reward will not fail.
9 All you who fear the Lord, hope for good things,
and for eternal gladness and mercy.
10 Look at the generations of old, and see:

§ **1:15** Gr. *nested.* † **1:18** Gr. *health of cure.* ‡ **1:18** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities: *Both are gifts of God for peace; glory opens out for those who love him. He saw her and took her measure.* § **1:21** Verse 21 is omitted by the best authorities: *The fear of the Lord drives away sins. Where it resides, it will turn away all anger.*

Who ever put his trust in the Lord,
and was ashamed?
Or who remained in his fear, and was
forsaken?
Or who called upon him, and he
neglected him?
11 For the Lord is full of compassion and
mercy.
He forgives sins and saves in time of
affliction.

12 Woe to fearful hearts, to faint hands,
and to the sinner who goes two ways!
13 Woe to the faint heart! For it doesn't
believe.
Therefore it won't be defended.
14 Woe to you who have lost your patience!
And what will you all do when the
Lord visits you?

15 Those who fear the Lord will not
disobey his words.
Those who love him will keep his
ways.
16 Those who fear the Lord will seek his
good pleasure.
Those who love him will be filled with
the law.
17 Those who fear the Lord will prepare
their hearts,
and will humble their souls in his
sight.
18 We will fall into the hands of the Lord,
and not into the hands of men;
for as his majesty is,
so also is his mercy.

3

1 Hear me, your father, O my children,
and do what you hear, that you all
may be safe.
2 For the Lord honors the father over the
children,
and has confirmed the judgment of
the mother over her sons.
3 He who honors his father will make
atonement for sins.
4 He who gives glory to his mother is
as one who lays up treasure.
5 Whoever honors his father will have joy
in his own children.
He will be heard in the day of his
prayer.
6 He who gives glory to his father will
have length of days.
He who listens to the Lord will bring
rest to his mother,
7 †and will serve under his parents, as to
masters.
8 Honor your father in deed and word,
that a blessing may come upon you
from him.
9 For the blessing of the father establishes
the houses of children,
but the curse of the mother roots out
the foundations.

10 Don't glorify yourself in the dishonor of
your father,
for your father's dishonor is no glory
to you.
11 For the glory of a man is from the honor
of his father,
and a mother in dishonor is a
reproach to her children.
12 My son, help your father in his old age,
and don't grieve him as long as he
lives.
13 If he fails in understanding, have
patience with him.
Don't dishonor him in your full
strength.
14 For the kindness to your father will not
be forgotten.
Instead of sins it will be added to
build you up.
15 In the day of your affliction it will be
remembered for you,
as fair weather upon ice,
so your sins will also melt away.
16 He who forsakes his father is as a
blasphemer.
He who provokes his mother is
cursed by the Lord.

17 My son, go on with your business in
humility;
so you will be loved by an acceptable
man.
18 The greater you are, humble yourself
the more,

† **3:7** Some manuscripts add *those who fear the Lord honor their father,* ‡ **3:19** Some manuscripts add *Many are lofty and renowned, but he reveals his secrets to the humble.*

and you will find favor before the Lord.
19 ‡

20 For the power of the Lord is great,
and he is glorified by those who are lowly.

21 Don't seek things that are too hard for you,
and don't search out things that are above your strength.

22 Think about the things that have been commanded you,
for you have no need of the things that are secret.

23 Don't be overly busy in tasks that are beyond you,
for more things are shown to you than men can understand.

24 For the conceit of many has led them astray.
Evil opinion has caused their judgment to slip.

25 §There is no light without eyes.
There is no wisdom without knowledge.

26 A stubborn heart will do badly at the end.
He who loves danger will perish in it.

27 A stubborn heart will be burdened with troubles.
The sinner will heap sin upon sins.

28 The calamity of the proud has no healing,
for a weed of wickedness has taken root in him.

29 The heart of the prudent will understand a proverb.
A wise man desires the ear of a listener.

30 Water will quench a flaming fire;
almsgiving will make atonement for sins.

31 He who repays good turns is mindful of that which comes afterward.
In the time of his falling he will find a support.

4

1 My son, don't deprive the poor of his living.
Don't make the needy eyes wait long.

2 Don't make a hungry soul sorrowful,
or provoke a man in his distress.

3 Don't add more trouble to a heart that is provoked.
Don't put off giving to him who is in need.

4 Don't reject a suppliant in his affliction.
Don't turn your face away from a poor man.

5 Don't turn your eye away from one who asks.
Give no occasion to a man to curse you.

6 For if he curses you in the bitterness of his soul,
he who made him will hear his supplication.

7 Endear yourself to the assembly.
Bow your head to a great man.

8 Incline your ear to a poor man.
Answer him with peaceful words in humility.

9 Deliver him who is wronged from the hand of him who wrongs him;
Don't be hesitant in giving judgment.

10 Be as a father to the fatherless,
and like a husband to their mother.
So you will be as a son of the Most High,
and he will love you more than your mother does.

11 Wisdom exalts her sons,
and takes hold of those who seek her.

12 He who loves her loves life.
Those who seek her early will be filled with gladness.

13 He who holds her fast will inherit glory.
Where† he enters, the Lord will bless.

14 Those who serve her minister to the Holy One.
The Lord loves those who love her.

15 He who listens to her will judge the nations.
He who heeds her will dwell securely.

16 If he trusts her, he will inherit her,
and his generations will possess her.

§ **3:25** Some manuscripts omit verse 25. † **4:13** Or, *she*

17 For at the first she will walk with him in
crooked ways,
and will bring fear and dread upon
him,
and torment him with her discipline,
until she may trust his soul, and try
him by her judgments.
18 Then she will return him again to the
straight way,
and will gladden him, and reveal to
him her secrets.
19 If he goes astray, she will forsake him,
and hand him over to his fall.

20 Watch for the opportunity, and beware
of evil.
Don't be ashamed of your soul.
21 For there is a shame that brings sin,
and there is a shame that is glory and
grace.
22 Don't show partiality, discrediting your
soul.
Don't revere any man to your falling.
23 Don't refrain from speaking when it is
for safety.
‡Don't hide your wisdom for the sake
of seeming fair.
24 For wisdom will be known by speech,
and instruction by the word of the
tongue.
25 Don't speak against the truth
and be shamed for your ignorance.
26 Don't be ashamed to confess your sins.
Don't fight the river's current.
27 Don't lay yourself down for a fool to
tread upon.
Don't be partial to one who is mighty.
28 Strive for the truth to death,
and the Lord God will fight for you.

29 Don't be hasty with your tongue,
or slack and negligent in your deeds.
30 Don't be like a lion in your house,
or suspicious of your servants.
31 Don't let your hand be stretched out to
receive,
and closed when you should repay.

5

1 Don't set your heart upon your goods.
Don't say, "They are sufficient for
me."
2 Don't follow your own mind and your
strength
to walk in the desires of your heart.
3 Don't say, "Who will have dominion over
me?"
for the Lord will surely take
vengeance on you.

4 Don't say, "I sinned, and what happened
to me?"
for the Lord is patient.
5 Don't be so confident of atonement
that you add sin upon sins.
6 Don't say, "His compassion is great.
He will be pacified for the multitude
of my sins,"
for mercy and wrath are with him,
and his indignation will rest on
sinners.
7 Don't wait to turn to the Lord.
Don't put off from day to day;
for suddenly the wrath of the Lord
will come on you,
and you will perish in the time of
vengeance.

8 Don't set your heart upon unrighteous
gains,
for you will profit nothing in the day
of calamity.
9 Don't winnow with every wind.
Don't walk in every path.
This is what the sinner who has a
double tongue does.
10 Be steadfast in your understanding.
Let your speech be consistent.

11 Be swift to hear
and answer with patience.
12 If you have understanding, answer
your neighbor;
but if not, put your hand over your
mouth.
13 Glory and dishonor is in talk.
A man's tongue may be his downfall.
14 Don't be called a whisperer.
Don't lie in wait with your tongue;
for shame is on the thief,
and an evil condemnation is on him
who has a double tongue.

‡ **4:23** Some manuscripts omit this line.

15 Don't be ignorant in a great or small
matter.

6

1 Don't become an enemy instead of a
friend;
for an evil name will inherit shame
and reproach.
So it is with the sinner who has a
double tongue.

2 Don't exalt yourself in the counsel of
your soul,
that your soul not be torn in pieces
like a bull.
3 You will eat up your leaves, destroy your
fruit,
and leave yourself like a dry tree.
4 A wicked soul will destroy him who has
it,
and will make him a laughing stock to
his enemies.

5 Sweet words will multiply a man's
friends.
A gracious tongue will multiply
courtesies.
6 Let those that are at peace with you be
many,
but your advisers one of a thousand.
7 If you want to gain a friend, get him in a
time of testing,
and don't be in a hurry to trust him.
8 For there is a friend just for an occasion.
He won't continue in the day of your
affliction.
9 And there is a friend who turns into an
enemy.
He will discover strife to your
reproach.
10 And there is a friend who is a
companion at the table,
but he won't continue in the day of
your affliction.
11 In your prosperity he will be as
yourself,
and will be bold over your servants.
12 If you are brought low, he will be
against you,
and will hide himself from your face.
13 Separate yourself from your enemies,
and beware of your friends.
14 A faithful friend is a strong defense.
He who has found him has found a
treasure.
15 There is nothing that can be taken in
exchange for a faithful friend.
His excellency is beyond price.
16 A faithful friend is a life-saving
medicine.
Those who fear the Lord will find him.
17 He who fears the Lord directs his
friendship properly;
for as he is, so is his neighbor also.

18 My son, gather instruction from your
youth up.
Even when you have gray hair you
will find wisdom.
19 Come to her as one who plows and sows
and wait for her good fruit;
for your toil will be little in her
cultivation,
and you will soon eat of her fruit.
20 How exceedingly harsh she is to the
unlearned!
He who is without understanding will
not remain in her.
21 She will rest upon him as a mighty stone
of trial.
He won't hesitate to cast her from
him.
22 For wisdom is according to her name.
She isn't manifest to many.

23 Give ear, my son, and accept my
judgment.
Don't refuse my counsel.
24 Bring your feet into her fetters,
and your neck into her chain.
25 Put your shoulder under her and bear
her.
Don't be grieved with her bonds.
26 Come to her with all your soul.
Keep her ways with your whole
power.
27 Search and seek, and she will be made
known to you.
When you get hold of her, don't let
her go.
28 For at the last you will find her rest;
and she will be turned for you into
gladness.
29 Her fetters will be to you for a covering
of strength,

and her chains for a robe of glory.
30 For there is a golden ornament upon her,
and her bands are *a purple cord.
31 You shall put her on as a robe of glory,
and shall put her on as a crown of rejoicing.

32 My son, if you are willing, you will be instructed.
If you will yield your soul, you will be prudent.
33 If you love to hear, you will receive.
If you incline your ear, you will be wise.
34 Stand in the multitude of the elders.
Attach yourself to whomever is wise.
35 Be willing to listen to every godly discourse.
Don't let the proverbs of understanding escape you.
36 If you see a man of understanding, get to him early.
Let your foot wear out the steps of his doors.
37 Let your mind dwell on the ordinances of the Lord
and meditate continually on his commandments.
He will establish your heart
and your desire for wisdom will be given to you.

7

1 Do no evil,
so no evil will overtake you.
2 Depart from wrong,
and it will turn away from you.
3 My son, don't sow upon the furrows of unrighteousness,
and you won't reap them sevenfold.

4 Don't seek preeminence from the Lord,
nor the seat of honor from the king.
5 Don't justify yourself in the presence of the Lord,
and don't display your wisdom before the king.
6 Don't seek to be a judge,
lest you not be able to take away iniquities,
lest perhaps you fear the person of a mighty man,
and lay a stumbling block in the way of your uprightness.

7 Don't sin against the multitude of the city.
Don't disgrace yourself in the crowd.

8 Don't commit a sin twice,
for even in one you will not be unpunished.
9 Don't say, "He will look upon the multitude of my gifts.
When I make an offering to the Most High God, he will accept it."
10 Don't be faint-hearted in your prayer.
Don't neglect to give alms.

11 Don't laugh a man to scorn when he is in the bitterness of his soul,
for there is one who humbles and exalts.
12 Don't devise† a lie against your brother,
or do the same to a friend.
13 Refuse to utter a lie,
for that habit results in no good.
14 Don't babble in the assembly of elders.
Don't repeat your words in your prayer.

15 Don't hate hard labor
or farm work, which the Most High has created.
16 Don't number yourself among the multitude of sinners.
Remember that wrath will not wait.
17 Humble your soul greatly,
for the punishment of the ungodly man is fire and the worm.

18 Don't exchange a friend for something,
neither a true brother for the gold of Ophir.
19 Don't deprive yourself of a wise and good wife,
for her grace is worth more than gold.
20 Don't abuse a servant who works faithfully,
or a hireling who gives you his life.

* **6:30** Numbers 15:38 † **7:12** Gr. *Don't plow*

21 Let your soul love a wise servant.
Don't defraud him of liberty.

22 Do you have cattle? Look after them.
If they are profitable to you, let them
stay by you.
23 Do you have children? Correct them,
and make them obedient from their
youth.
24 Do you have daughters? Take care of
their bodies,
and don't be overly indulgent toward
them.
25 Give your daughter in marriage, and
you will have accomplished a great
matter.
Give her to a man of understanding.

26 Do you have a wife who pleases you?
Don't cast her out.
‡But don't trust yourself to one who is
hateful.

27 Honor your father with your whole
heart,
and don't forget the birth pangs of
your mother.
28 Remember that you were born of them.
What will you repay them for the
things that they have done for you?

29 Fear the Lord with all your soul;
and revere his priests.
30 With all your strength love him who
made you.
Don't forsake his ministers.
31 Fear the Lord and honor the priest.
Give him his portion, even as it is
commanded you:
the first fruits, the trespass offering,
the gift of the shoulders,
the sacrifice of sanctification, and the
first fruits of holy things.

32 Also stretch out your hand to the poor
man,
that your blessing may be complete.
33 A gift has grace in the sight of every
living man.
Don't withhold grace for a dead man.
34 Don't avoid those who weep,
and mourn with those who mourn.
35 Don't be slow to visit a sick man,
for by such things you will gain love.
36 In all your words, remember eternity,
and you will never sin.

8

1 Don't contend with a mighty man,
lest perhaps you fall into his hands.
2 Don't strive with a rich man, lest perhaps
he overpower you;
for gold has destroyed many,
and turned away the hearts of kings.
3 Don't argue with a loudmouthed man.
Don't heap wood upon his fire.

4 Don't make fun of a rude man,
lest your ancestors be dishonored.
5 Don't reproach a man when he turns
from sin.
Remember that we are all worthy of
punishment.
6 Don't dishonor a man in his old age,
for some of us are also growing old.
7 Don't rejoice over anyone's death.
Remember that we all die.

8 Don't neglect the discourse of the wise.
Be conversant with their proverbs;
for from them you will learn
discipline
and how to serve great men.
9 Don't miss the discourse of the aged,
for they also learned from their
parents,
because from them you will learn
understanding,
and to give an answer in time of need.

10 Don't kindle the coals of a sinner,
lest you be burned with the flame of
his fire.
11 Don't rise up from the presence of an
insolent man,
lest he lie in wait as an ambush for
your mouth.
12 Don't lend to a man who is stronger
than you;
and if you lend, count it as a loss.
13 Don't be surety beyond your means.

‡ **7:26** Many authorities omit this line

If you give surety, think as one who
will have to pay.

14 Don't go to law with a judge;
for according to his honor they will
give judgment for him.
15 Don't travel with a reckless man,
lest he be burdensome to you;
for he will do as he pleases,
and you will perish with his folly.
16 Don't fight with a wrathful man.
Don't travel with him through the
desert,
for blood is as nothing in his sight.
Where there is no help, he will
overthrow you.
17 Don't consult with a fool,
for he will not be able to keep a secret.
18 Do no secret thing before a stranger,
for you don't know what it will cause.
19 Don't open your heart to every man.
Don't let him return you a favor.

9

1 Don't be jealous over the wife of your
bosom,
and don't teach her an evil lesson
against yourself.
2 Don't give your soul to a woman
and let her trample down your
strength.
3 Don't go to meet a woman who plays the
prostitute,
lest perhaps you fall into her snares.
4 Don't associate with a woman who is a
singer,
lest perhaps you be caught by her
tricks.
5 Don't gaze at a virgin,
lest perhaps you stumble and incur
penalties for her.
6 Don't give your soul to prostitutes,
that you not lose your inheritance.
7 Don't look around in the streets of the
city.
Don't wander in its deserted places.
8 Turn your eye away from a beautiful
woman,
and don't gaze at another's beauty.
Many have been led astray by the beauty
of a woman;
and with this, passion is kindled like a
fire.
9 Don't dine at all with a woman who has a
husband,
or revel with her at wine,†
lest perhaps your soul turn away to
her,
and with your spirit you slide into
destruction.

10 Don't forsake an old friend;
for a new one is not comparable to
him.
A new friend is like new wine:
if it becomes old, you will drink it
with gladness.

11 Don't envy the success of a sinner;
for you don't know what his end will
be.
12 Don't delight in the delights of the
ungodly.
Remember they will not go
unpunished to‡ the grave.

13 Keep yourself far from the man who
has§ power to kill,
and you will not be troubled by the
fear of death.
If you come to him, commit no fault,
lest he take away your life.
Know surely that you go about in the
midst of snares,
and walk upon the battlements of a
city.

14 As well as you can, aim to know your
neighbors,
and take counsel with the wise.
15 Let your conversation be with men of
understanding.
Let all your discourse be in the law of
the Most High.
16 Let righteous people be companions at
your table.
Let your glorying be in the fear of the
Lord.

† **9:9** The preceding line of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **9:12** Gr. *Hades.* § **9:13** Or, *authority*

17 A work is commended because of the skill of the artisan;
so he who rules the people will be considered wise for his speech.
18 A loudmouthed man is dangerous in his city.
He who is reckless in his speech will be hated.

10

1 A wise judge will instruct his people.
The government of a man of understanding will be well ordered.
2 As is the judge of his people, so are his officials.
As the city's ruler is, so are all those who dwell in it.
3 An undisciplined king will destroy his people.
A city will be established through the understanding of the powerful.
4 The government of the earth is in the Lord's hand.
In due time, he will raise up over it the right person at the right time.
5 A man's prosperity is in the Lord's hand.
He will lay his honor upon the person of the scribe.

6 Don't be angry with your neighbor for every wrong.
Do nothing by works of violence.
7 Pride is hateful before the Lord and men.
Arrogance is abhorrent in the judgment of both.
8 Sovereignty is transferred from nation to nation
because of injustice, violence, and greed for money.
9 Why are dirt and ashes proud?†
Because in life, my body decays.
10 A long disease mocks the physician.
The king of today will die tomorrow.
11 For when a man is dead,
he will inherit maggots, vermin, and worms.
12 It is the beginning of pride when a man departs from the Lord.
His heart has departed from him who made him.
13 For the beginning of pride is sin.
He who keeps it will pour out abomination.
For this cause the Lord brought upon them strange calamities
and utterly overthrew them.
14 The Lord cast down the thrones of rulers
and set the lowly in their place.
15 The Lord plucked up the roots of nations
and planted the lowly in their place.
16 The Lord overthrew the lands of nations
and destroyed them to the foundations of the earth.
17 He took some of them away and destroyed them,
and made their memory to cease from the earth.
18 Pride has not been created for men,
nor wrathful anger for the offspring of women.

19 Whose offspring has honor?
Human offspring who fear the Lord.
Whose offspring has no honor?
Human offspring who break the commandments.
20 In the midst of kindred he who rules them has honor.
Those who fear the Lord have honor in his eyes.
21 ‡
22 The rich man, the honorable, and the poor
all glory in the fear of the Lord.
23 It is not right to dishonor a poor man who has understanding.
It is not fitting to glorify a man who is a sinner.
24 The prince, the judge, and the mighty man will be honored.
There is not one of them greater than he who fears the Lord.
25 Free men will minister to a wise servant.
A man who has knowledge will not complain.

† **10:9** Two lines of this verse are here omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **10:21** Verse 21 is omitted by the best authorities: Fear of the Lord is the beginning of acceptance, but obstinance and pride are the beginning of rejection.

26 Don't flaunt your wisdom in doing your
work.
Don't boast in the time of your
distress.
27 Better is he who labors and abounds in
all things,
than he who boasts and lacks bread.
28 My son, glorify your soul in humility,
and ascribe to yourself honor
according to your worthiness.
29 Who will justify him who sins against
his own soul?
Who will honor him who dishonors
his own life?

30 A poor man is honored for his
knowledge.
A rich man is honored for his riches.
31 But he who is honored in poverty, how
much more in riches?
He who is dishonored in riches, how
much more in poverty?

11

1 The wisdom of the lowly will lift up his
head,
and make him sit in the midst of great
men.

2 Don't commend a man for his good looks.
Don't abhor a man for his outward
appearance.
3 The bee is little among flying creatures,
but what it produces is the best of
confections.
4 Don't boast about the clothes you wear,
and don't exalt yourself in the day of
honor;
for the Lord's works are wonderful,
and his works are hidden among
men.
5 Many† kings have sat down upon the
ground,
but one who was never thought of has
worn a crown.
6 Many mighty men have been greatly
disgraced.
Men of renown have been delivered
into other men's hands.

7 Don't blame before you investigate.
Understand first, and then rebuke.
8 Don't answer before you have heard.
Don't interrupt while someone else is
speaking.
9 Don't argue about a matter that doesn't
concern you.
Don't sit with sinners when they
judge.

10 My son, don't be busy about many
matters;
for if you meddle much, you will not
be unpunished.
If you pursue, you will not overtake,
and you will not escape by fleeing.
11 There is one who toils, labors, and
hurries,
and is even more behind.
12 There is one who is sluggish, and needs
help,
lacking in strength, and who abounds
in poverty,
but the Lord's eyes looked upon him for
good,
and he raised him up from his low
condition,
13 and lifted up his head
so that many marveled at him.

14 Good things and bad, life and death,
poverty and riches, are from the Lord.
15-16 ‡
17 The Lord's gift remains with the godly.
His good pleasure will prosper
forever.
18 One grows rich by his diligence and
self-denial,
and this is the portion of his reward:
19 when he says, "I have found rest,
and now I will eat of my goods!"
he doesn't know how much time will pass
until he leaves them to others and
dies.
20 Be steadfast in your covenant and be
doing it,
and grow old in your work.

21 Don't marvel at the works of a sinner,
but trust the Lord and stay in your
labor;
for it is an easy thing in the sight of the
Lord

† **11:5** Gr. *tyrants* ‡ **11:15-16** Verses 15 and 16 are omitted by the best authorities.

to swiftly and suddenly make a poor
man rich.
22 The Lord's blessing is in the reward of
the godly.
He makes his blessing flourish in an
hour that comes swiftly.
23 Don't say, "What use is there of me?
What further good things can be
mine?"
24 Don't say, "I have enough.
What harm could happen to me
now?"
25 In the day of good things, bad things are
forgotten.
In the day of bad things, a man will
not remember things that are good.
26 For it is an easy thing in the sight of the
Lord
to reward a man in the day of death
according to his ways.
27 The affliction of an hour causes delights
to be forgotten.
In the end, a man's deeds are
revealed.
28 Call no man happy before his death.
A man will be known in his children.

29 Don't bring every man into your house,
for many are the tricks of a deceitful
man.
30 Like a decoy partridge in a cage, so is
the heart of a proud man.
Like a spy, he looks for your
weakness.
31 For he lies in wait to turn things that are
good into evil,
and assigns blame in things that are
praiseworthy.
32 From a spark of fire, a heap of many
coals is kindled,
and a sinful man lies in wait to shed
blood.
33 Take heed of an evil-doer, for he plans
wicked things,
lest perhaps he ruin your reputation
forever.
34 Receive a stranger into your house, and
he will distract you with arguments
and estrange you from your own
family.

12

1 If you do good, know to whom you do it,
and your good deeds will have
thanks.
2 Do good to a godly man, and you will
find a reward—
if not from him, then from the Most
High.
3 No good will come to him who continues
to do evil,
nor to him who gives no alms.
4 Give to the godly man,
and don't help the sinner.
5 Do good to one who is lowly.
Don't give to an ungodly man.
Keep back his bread, and don't give it to
him,
lest he subdue you with it;
for you would receive twice as much evil
for all the good you would have done
to him.
6 For the Most High also hates sinners,
and will repay vengeance to the
ungodly.†
7 Give to the good man,
and don't help the sinner.

8 A man's friend won't be‡ fully tried in
prosperity.
His enemy won't be hidden in
adversity.
9 In a man's prosperity, his enemies are
grieved.
In his adversity, even his friend
leaves.
10 Never trust your enemy,
for his wickedness is like corrosion in
copper.
11 Though he humbles himself and walks
bowed down,
still be careful and beware of him.
You will be to him as one who has wiped a
mirror,
to be sure it doesn't completely
tarnish.
12 Don't set him next to you,
lest he overthrow you and stand in
your place.
Don't let him sit on your right hand,
lest he seek to take your seat,

† **12:6** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **12:8** Or, *punished*

and at the last you acknowledge my
words,
and be pricked with my sayings.

13 Who will pity a charmer that is bitten
by a snake,
or any who come near wild beasts?
14 Even so, who will pity him who goes to a
sinner,
and is associated with him in his sins?
15 For a while he will stay with you,
and if you falter, he will not stay.
16 The enemy will speak sweetly with his
lips,
and in his heart plan to throw you
into a pit.
The enemy may weep with his eyes,
but if he finds opportunity, he will
want more blood.
17 If adversity meets you, you will find
him there before you.
Pretending to help you, he will trip
you.
18 He will shake his head, clap his hands,
whisper much, and change his
countenance.

13

1 He who touches pitch will be defiled.
He who has fellowship with a proud
man will become like him.
2 Don't take up a burden above your
strength.
Have no fellowship with one who is
mightier and richer than yourself.
What fellowship would the earthen pot
have with the kettle?
The kettle will strike, and the pot will
be dashed in pieces.
3 The rich man does a wrong and
threatens.
The poor is wronged and apologizes.
4 If you are profitable, he will exploit you.
If you are in need, he will forsake you.
5 If you own something, he will live with
you.
He will drain your resources and will
not be sorry.
6 Does he need you? Then he will deceive
you,
smile at you, and give you hope.
He will speak kindly to you and say,
"What do you need?"
7 He will shame you by his delicacies
until he has made you bare twice or
thrice,
and in the end he will laugh you to
scorn.
Afterward he will see you, will forsake
you,
and shake his head at you.

8 Beware that you are not deceived
and brought low in your enjoyment.
9 If a mighty man invites you, be reserved,
and he will invite you more.
10 Don't press him, lest you be thrust back.
Don't stand far off, lest you be
forgotten.
11 Don't try to speak with him as an equal,
and don't believe his many words;
for he will test you with much talk,
and will examine you in a smiling
manner.
12 He who doesn't keep secrets to himself
is unmerciful.
He won't hesitate to harm and to bind.
13 Keep them to yourself and be careful,
for you walk† in danger of falling.
14 ‡

15 Every living creature loves its own kind,
and every man loves his neighbor.
16 All flesh associates with their own kind.
A man will stick to people like
himself.
17 What fellowship would the wolf have
with the lamb?
So is the sinner to the godly.
18 What peace is there between a hyena
and a dog?
What peace is there between a rich
man and the poor?
19 Wild donkeys are the prey of lions in
the wilderness;
likewise poor men are feeding
grounds for the rich.
20 Lowliness is an abomination to a proud
man;
likewise a poor man is an
abomination to the rich.

† **13:13** Gr. *along with.* ‡ **13:14** The remainder of verse 13, and verse 14, are omitted by the best authorities.

21 When a rich man is shaken, he is
supported by his friends,
but when the humble is down, he is
pushed away even by his friends.
22 When a rich man falls, there are many
helpers.
He speaks things not to be spoken,
and men justify him.
A humble man falls, and men rebuke him.
He utters wisdom, and is not listened
to.
23 A rich man speaks, and all keep silence.
They extol what he says to the clouds.
A poor man speaks, and they say, “Who is
this?”
If he stumbles, they will help to
overthrow him.

24 Riches are good if they have no sin.
Poverty is evil only in the opinion of
the ungodly.

25 The heart of a man changes his
countenance,
whether it is for good or for evil.§
26 A cheerful countenance is a sign of a
prosperous heart.
Devising proverbs takes strenuous
thinking.

14

1 Blessed is the man who has not slipped
with his mouth,
and doesn’t suffer from sorrow for
sins.
2 Blessed is he whose soul does not
condemn him,
and who has not given up hope.

3 Riches are not appropriate for a stingy
person.
What would a miser do with money?
4 He who gathers by denying himself
gathers for others.
Others will revel in his goods.
5 If one is mean to himself, to whom will
he be good?
He won’t enjoy his possessions.
6 There is none more evil than he who is
grudging to himself.
This is a punishment for his
wickedness.
7 Even if he does good, he does it in
forgetfulness.
In the end, he reveals his wickedness.
8 A miser is evil.
He turns away and disregards souls.
9 A covetous man’s eye is not satisfied with
his portion.
Wicked injustice dries up his soul.
10 A miser begrudges bread,
and it is lacking at his table.

11 My son, according to what you have,
treat yourself well,
and bring worthy offerings to the
Lord.
12 Remember that death will not wait,
and that the covenant of Hades hasn’t
been shown to you.
13 Do good to your friends before you die.
According to your ability, reach out
and give to them.
14 Don’t deprive yourself of a good day.
Don’t let your share of a desired good
pass you by.
15 Won’t you leave your labors to another,
and your toils be divided by lot?
16 Give, take, and treat yourself well,
because there is no seeking of luxury
in Hades.
17 All flesh grows old like a garment,
for the covenant from the beginning
is, “You must die!”
18 Like the leaves flourishing on a thick
tree,
some it sheds, and some grow,
so also are the generations of flesh and
blood:
one comes to an end and another is
born.
19 Every work rots and falls away,
and its builder will depart with it.

20 Blessed is the man who meditates on
wisdom,
and who reasons by his
understanding.
21 He who considers her ways in his heart
will also have knowledge of her
secrets.
22 Go after her like a hunter,
and lie in wait in her paths.

§ **13:25** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities.

23 He who peers in at her windows
will also listen at her doors.
24 He who lodges close to her house
will also fasten a nail in her walls.
25 He will pitch his tent near at hand to her,
and will lodge in a lodging where good things are.
26 He will set his children under her shelter,
and will rest under her branches.
27 By her he will be covered from heat,
and will lodge in her glory.

15

1 He who fears the Lord will do this.
He who has possession of the law will obtain her.
2 She will meet him like a mother,
and receive him like a wife married in her virginity.
3 She will feed him with bread of understanding
and give him water of wisdom to drink.
4 He will be stayed upon her, and will not be moved.
He will rely upon her, and will not be confounded.
5 She will exalt him above his neighbors.
She will open his mouth in the midst of the congregation.
6 He will inherit joy, a crown of gladness,
and an everlasting name.
7 Foolish men will not obtain her.
Sinners will not see her.
8 She is far from pride.
Liars will not remember her.
9 Praise is not attractive in the mouth of a sinner;
for it was not sent to him from the Lord.
10 For praise will be spoken in wisdom;
The Lord will prosper it.

11 Don't say, "It is through the Lord that I fell away;"
for you shall not do the things that he hates.
12 Don't say, "It is he that caused me to err;"
for he has no need of a sinful man.
13 The Lord hates every abomination;
and those who fear him don't love them.
14 He himself made man from the beginning
and left him in the hand of his own counsel.
15 If you choose, you can keep the commandments.
To be faithful is a matter of your choice.
16 He has set fire and water before you.
You will stretch forth your hand to whichever you desire.
17 Before man is life and death.
Whichever he likes, it will be given to him.
18 For the wisdom of the Lord is great.
He is mighty in power, and sees all things.
19 His eyes are upon those who fear him.
He knows every act of man.
20 He has not commanded any man to be ungodly.
He has not given any man license to sin.

16

1 Don't desire a multitude of unprofitable children,
neither delight in ungodly sons.
2 If they multiply, don't delight in them
unless the fear of the Lord is in them.
3 Don't trust in their life.
Don't rely on their numbers;
for one can be better than a thousand,
and to die childless than to have ungodly children.
4 For from one who has understanding, a city will be populated,
but a race of wicked men will be made desolate.
5 I have seen many such things with my eyes.
My ear has heard mightier things than these.

6 In a congregation of sinners, a fire will be kindled.
In a disobedient nation, wrath is kindled.
7 He was not pacified toward the giants of old time,
who revolted in their strength.

8 He didn't spare Lot's neighbors,
whom he abhorred for their pride.
9 He didn't pity the people of perdition
who were taken away in their sins,
10 or in like manner, the six hundred thousand footmen
who were gathered together in the hardness of their hearts.
11 Even if there is one stiff-necked person,
it is a marvel if he will be unpunished;
for mercy and wrath are both with him who is mighty to forgive,
and he pours out wrath.
12 As his mercy is great, so is his correction also.
He judges a man according to his works.
13 The sinner will not escape with plunder.
The perseverance of the godly will not be frustrated.
14 He will make room for every work of mercy.
Each man will receive according to his works.
15-16 †

17 Don't say, "I will be hidden from the Lord,"
and "Who will remember me from on high?"
I will not be known among so many people,
for what is my soul in a boundless creation?
18 Behold, heaven, the heaven of heavens,
the deep, and the earth, will be moved when he visits.
19 The mountains and the foundations of the earth together
are shaken with trembling when he looks at them.
20 No heart will think about these things.
Who could comprehend his ways?
21 Like a tempest which no man can see,
so, the majority of his works are‡ hidden.
22 Who will declare his works of righteousness?
Who will wait for them?
For his covenant is afar off.§
23 He who is lacking in† understanding
thinks about these things.
An unwise and erring man thinks foolishly.

24 My son, listen to me, learn knowledge,
and heed my words with your heart.
25 I will impart instruction with precision,
and declare knowledge exactly.

26 In the judgment of the Lord are his works from the beginning.
From the making of them he determined their boundaries.
27 He arranged his works for all time,
and their beginnings to their generations.
They aren't hungry or weary,
and they don't cease from their works.
28 No one pushes aside his neighbor.
They will never disobey his word.
29 After this also the Lord looked at the earth
and filled it with his blessings.
30 All manner of living things covered its surface,
and they return into it.

17

1 The Lord created mankind out of earth,
and turned them back to it again.
2 He gave them days by number, and a set time,
and gave them authority over the things that are on it.
3 He endowed them with strength proper to them,
and made them according to his own image.
4 He put the fear of man upon all flesh,
and gave him dominion over beasts and birds.
5 †
6 He gave them counsel, tongue, eyes,
ears, and heart to have understanding.
7 He filled them with the knowledge of wisdom,

† **16:15-16** Verses 15 and 16 are omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **16:21** Gr. *among hidden things.* § **16:22** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. † **16:23** Gr. *heart.* † **17:5** Verse 5 is omitted by the best authorities.

and showed them good and evil.
8 He set his eye upon their hearts,
to show them the majesty of his works.
9 ‡
10 And they will praise his holy name,
§that they may declare the majesty of his works.
11 He added to them knowledge,
and gave them a law of life for a heritage.
12 He made an everlasting covenant with them,
and showed them his decrees.
13 Their eyes saw the majesty of his glory.
Their ears heard the glory of his voice.
14 He said to them, “Beware of all unrighteousness.”
So he gave them commandment, each man concerning his neighbor.

15 Their ways are ever before him.
They will not be hidden from his eyes.
16 †
17 ‡For every nation he appointed a ruler,
but Israel is the Lord’s portion.
18 §
19 All their works are as clear as the sun before him.
His eyes are continually upon their ways.
20 Their iniquities are not hidden from him.
All their sins are before the Lord.
21 †
22 With him the alms of a man is as a signet.
He will keep a man’s kindness as the pupil of the eye.‡
23 Afterwards he will rise up and repay them,
and give their repayment upon their head.
24 However to those who repent he grants a return.
He comforts those who are losing hope.
25 Return to the Lord, and forsake sins.
Make your prayer before his face offend less.
26 Turn again to the Most High, and turn away from iniquity.§
Greatly hate the abominable thing.
27 Who will give praise to the Most High in Hades,
in place of the living who return thanks?
28 Thanksgiving perishes from the dead,
as from one who doesn’t exist.
He who is in life and health will praise the Lord.
29 How great is the mercy of the Lord,
and his forgiveness to those who turn to him!
30 For humans are not capable of everything,
because the son of man is not immortal.
31 What is brighter than the sun? Yet even this can be eclipsed.
So flesh and blood devise evil.
32 He looks upon the power of the height of heaven,
while all men are earth and ashes.

18

1 He who lives forever created the whole universe.
2 The Lord alone is just.
3 †
4 He has given power to declare his works to no one.
Who could trace out his mighty deeds?
5 Who could measure the strength of his majesty?
Who could also proclaim his mercies?
6 As for the wondrous works of the Lord, it is not possible to take from them nor add to them,
neither is it possible to explore them.
7 When a man has finished, then he is just at the beginning.

‡ **17:9** Verse 9 is omitted by the best authorities. § **17:10** This line is added by the best authorities. † **17:16** Verses 16, 18, and 21 are omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **17:17** The preceding part of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. § **17:18** Verses 16, 18, and 21 are omitted by the best authorities. † **17:21** Verses 16, 18, and 21 are omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **17:22** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. § **17:26** A line is here omitted by the best authorities. † **18:3** The remainder of verse 2, and verse 3, are omitted by the best authorities.

When he stops, then he will be
perplexed.
8 What is mankind, and what purpose do
they serve?
What is their good, and what is their
evil?
9 The number of man's days at the most
are a hundred years.
10 As a drop of water from the sea, and a
pebble from the sand,
so are a few years in the day of
eternity.
11 For this cause the Lord was patient over
them,
and poured out his mercy upon them.
12 He saw and perceived their end, that it
is evil.
Therefore he multiplied his
forgiveness.
13 The mercy of a man is on his neighbor;
but the mercy of the Lord is on all
flesh:
reproving, chastening, teaching,
and bringing back, as a shepherd
does his flock.
14 He has mercy on those who accept
chastening,
and that diligently seek after his
judgments.

15 My son, don't add reproach to your
good deeds,
and no harsh words in any of your
giving.
16 Doesn't the dew relieve the scorching
heat?
So a word is better than a gift.
17 Behold, isn't a word better than a gift?
Both are with a gracious person.
18 A fool is ungracious and abusive.
The gift of a grudging person
consumes the eyes.

19 Learn before you speak.
Take care of your health before you
get sick.
20 Before judgment, examine yourself,
and in the hour of scrutiny you will
find forgiveness.
21 Humble yourself before you get sick.
In the time of sins, repent.
22 Let nothing hinder you to pay your vow
in due time.
Don't wait until death to be released.
23 Before you make a vow, prepare
yourself.
Don't be like a man who tests the
Lord.
24 Think about the wrath coming in the
days of the end,
and the time of vengeance, when he
turns away his face.
25 In the days of fullness remember the
time of hunger.
Remember poverty and lack in the
days of wealth.
26 From morning until evening, the time
changes.
All things are speedy before the Lord.
27 A wise man is cautious in everything.
In days of sinning, he will beware of
offense.‡
28 Every man of understanding knows
wisdom.
He will give thanks to him who found
her.
29 They who were of understanding in
sayings also became wise
themselves,
and poured out apt proverbs.

30 Don't go after your lusts.
Restrain your appetites.
31 If you give fully to your soul the delight
of her desire,
she will make you§ the laughing stock
of your enemies.
32 Don't make merry in much luxury,
and don't be tied to its expense.
33 Don't be made a beggar by banqueting
with borrowed money
when you have nothing in your
purse.†

19

1 A worker who is a drunkard will not
become rich.

‡ **18:27** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. § **18:31** Or, *a rejoicing to* † **18:33** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities.

He who despises small things will fall
little by little.
2 Wine and women will make men of
understanding go astray.
He who joins with prostitutes is
reckless.
3 Decay and worms will have him as their
heritage.
A reckless soul will be taken away.

4 He who is hasty to trust is
shallow-hearted.
He who sins offends against his own
soul.
5 He who rejoices in wickedness will be
condemned.†
6 ‡He who hates gossip has less
wickedness.
7 Never repeat what is told you,
and you won't lose anything.
8 Whether it is of friend or foe, don't tell it.
Unless it is a sin to you, don't reveal it.
9 For if he has heard you and observed
you,
when the time comes, he will hate
you.
10 Have you heard something? Let it die
with you.
Be brave: it will not make you burst!
11 A fool will travail in pain with a word,
as a woman in labor with a child.
12 As an arrow that sticks in the flesh of
the thigh,
so is gossip in a fool.

13 Question a friend; it may be he didn't do
it.
If he did something, it may be that he
may do it no more.
14 Question your neighbor; it may be he
didn't say it.
If he has said it, it may be that he may
not say it again.
15 Question a friend; for many times there
is slander.
Don't trust every word.
16 There is one who slips, and not from the
heart.
Who is he who hasn't sinned with his
tongue?
17 Reprove your neighbor before you
threaten him;
and give place to the law of the Most
High.
18-19 §

20 All wisdom is the fear of the Lord.
In all wisdom is the doing of the law.
21 †
22 The knowledge of wickedness is not
wisdom.
The prudence of sinners is not
counsel.
23 There is a wickedness, and it is an
abomination.
There is a fool lacking in wisdom.
24 Better is one who has little
understanding, and fears God,
than one who has much intelligence
and transgresses the law.
25 There is an exquisite subtlety, and it is
unjust.
And there is one who perverts favor
to gain a judgment.‡
26 There is one who does wickedly, who
hangs down his head with
mourning;
but inwardly he is full of deceit,
27 bowing down his face, and
pretending to be deaf in one ear.
Where he isn't known, he will take
advantage of you.
28 And if for lack of power he is hindered
from sinning,
if he finds opportunity, he will do
mischief.
29 A man will be known by his
appearance.
One who has understanding will be
known by his face when you meet
him.
30 A man's attire, grinning laughter,
and the way he walks show what he
is.

† **19:5** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **19:6** The preceding part of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. § **19:18-19** Verses 18 and 19 are omitted by the best authorities. † **19:21** The remainder of verse 20 and verse 21 are omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **19:25** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities.

20

1 There is a reproof that is not timely;
and there is a person who is wise
enough to keep silent.
2 How good is it to reprove, rather than to
be angry.
He who confesses will be kept back
from harm.
3 †
4 As is the lust of a eunuch to deflower a
virgin,
so is he who executes judgments with
violence.
5 There is one who keeps silent and is
found wise;
and there is one who is hated for his
much talk.
6 There is one who keeps silent, for he has
no answer to make;
And there is one who keeps silent,
knowing when to speak.
7 A wise man will be silent until his time
has come,
but the braggart and fool will miss his
time.
8 He who uses many words will be
abhorred.
He who takes authority for himself
will be hated in it.

9 There is a prosperity that a man finds in
misfortunes;
and there is a gain that turns to loss.
10 There is a gift that will not profit you;
and there is a gift that pays back
double.
11 There are losses because of glory;
and there is one who has lifted up his
head from a low estate.
12 There is one who buys much for a little,
and pays for it again sevenfold.
13 He who is wise in words will make
himself beloved;
but the pleasantries of fools will be
wasted.
14 The gift of a fool will not profit you,‡
for he looks for repayment many
times instead of one.
15 He will give little and insult much.
He will open his mouth like a crier.
Today he will lend, and tomorrow he will
ask for it back.
Such a one is a hateful man.
16 The fool will say, “I have no friend,
and I have no thanks for my good
deeds.
Those who eat my bread have an evil
tongue.”
17 How often, and of how many, will he be
laughed to scorn!§

18 A slip on a pavement is better than a
slip with the tongue.
So the fall of the wicked will come
speedily.
19 A man without grace is a tale out of
season.
It will be continually in the mouth of
the ignorant.
20 A parable from a fool’s mouth will be
rejected;
for he won’t tell it at the proper time.

21 There is one who is hindered from
sinning through lack.
When he rests, he will not be
troubled.
22 There is one who destroys his soul
through bashfulness.
By a foolish countenance, he will
destroy it.
23 There is one who for bashfulness makes
promises to his friend;
and he makes him his enemy for
nothing.

24 A lie is an ugly blot on a person.
It will be continually in the mouth of
the ignorant.
25 A thief is better than a man who is
continually lying,
but they both will inherit destruction.
26 The destination of a liar is dishonor.
His shame is with him continually.

27 He who is wise in words will advance
himself.
And one who is prudent will please
great men.
28 He who tills his land will raise his
harvest high.

† **20:3** Verse 3 is omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **20:14** A line of this verse is here omitted by the best authorities.
§ **20:17** The latter part of verse 17 is omitted by the best authorities.

He who pleases great men will get
pardon for iniquity.
29 Favors and gifts blind the eyes of the
wise,
and as a muzzle on the mouth, turn
away reproofs.
30 Wisdom that is hidden, and treasure
that is out of sight—
what profit is in either of them?
31 Better is a man who hides his folly
than a man who hides his wisdom.
32 †

21

1 My son, have you sinned?
Do it no more;
and ask forgiveness for your past sins.
2 Flee from sin as from the face of a snake;
for if you go near, it will bite you.
Its teeth are like lion's teeth,
slaying people's souls.
3 All iniquity is as a two-edged sword.
Its stroke has no healing.

4 Terror and violence will waste away
riches.
So the house of an arrogant man will
be laid waste.
5 Supplication from a poor man's mouth
reaches to the ears of† God,
and his judgment comes speedily.
6 One who hates reproof is in the path of
the sinner.
He who fears the Lord will repent in
his heart.
7 He who is mighty in tongue is known far
away;
but the man of understanding knows
when he slips.

8 He who builds his house with other
men's money
is like one who gathers stones for his
own tomb.
9 The congregation of wicked men is as a
bundle of tow
with a flame of fire at the end of them.
10 The way of sinners is paved with stones;
and at the end of it is the pit of Hades.
11 He who keeps the law becomes master
of its intent.
The fulfilment of the fear of the Lord
is wisdom.
12 He who is not clever will not be
instructed.
There is a cleverness which makes
bitterness abound.
13 The knowledge of a wise man will be
made to abound as a flood,
and his counsel as a fountain of life.
14 The inward parts of a fool are like a
broken vessel.
He will hold no knowledge.

15 If a man of knowledge hears a wise
word,
he will commend it and add to it.
The wanton man hears it, and it
displeases him,
so he throws it away behind his back.
16 The chatter of a fool is like a burden in
the way,
but grace will be found on the lips of
the wise.
17 The utterance of the prudent man will
be sought for in the congregation.
They will ponder his words in their
heart.

18 As a house that is destroyed, so is
wisdom to a fool.
The knowledge of an unwise man is
talk without sense.‡
19 Instruction is as fetters on the feet of an
unwise man,
and as manacles on the right hand.
20 A fool lifts up his voice with laughter,
but a clever man smiles quietly.
21 Instruction is to a prudent man as an
ornament of gold,
and as a bracelet upon his right arm.

22 The foot of a fool rushes into a house,
but a man of experience will be
ashamed of entering.
23 A foolish man peers into the door of a
house,
but a man who is instructed will
stand outside.
24 It is rude for someone to listen at a door,
but a prudent person will be grieved
with the disgrace.

† **20:32** Verse 32 is omitted by the best authorities. † **21:5** Gr. *him.* ‡ **21:18** Gr. *unexamined words.*

25 The lips of strangers will be grieved at
these things,
but the words of prudent men will be
weighed in the balance.

26 The heart of fools is in their mouth,
but the mouth of wise men is their
heart.
27 When the ungodly curses an adversary,
he curses his own soul.
28 A whisperer defiles his own soul,
and will be hated wherever he
travels.

22

1 A slothful man is compared to a stone
that is defiled.
Everyone will hiss at him in his
disgrace.
2 A slothful man is compared to the filth of
a dunghill.
Anyone who picks it up will shake it
out of his hand.

3 An undisciplined child is a disgrace to
his father,
and a foolish daughter is born to his
loss.
4 A prudent daughter will inherit a
husband of her own.
She who brings shame is the grief of
her father.
5 She who is arrogant brings shame on
father and husband.
She will be despised by both of them.
6 Ill-timed conversation is like music in
mourning,
but stripes and correction are
wisdom in every season.

7 He who teaches a fool is like one who
glues potsherds together,
even like one who wakes a sleeper out
of a deep sleep.
8 He who teaches a fool is as one who
teaches a man who slumbers.
In the end he will say, “What is it?”
9-10 †
11 Weep for the dead, for he lacks light.
Weep for a fool, for he lacks
understanding.
Weep more sweetly for the dead, because
he has found rest,
but the life of the fool is worse than
death.
12 Mourning for the dead lasts seven days,
but for a fool and an ungodly man, it
lasts all the days of his life.

13 Don’t talk much with a foolish man,
and don’t go to one who has no
understanding.
Beware of him, lest you have trouble and
be defiled in his onslaught.
Turn away from him, and you will
find rest,
and you won’t be wearied in his
madness.
14 What would be heavier than lead?
What is its name, but “Fool”?
15 Sand, salt, and a mass of iron is easier to
bear
than a man without understanding.

16 Timber girded and bound into a
building will not be released with
shaking.
So a heart established in due season
on well advised counsel will not be
afraid.
17 A heart settled upon a thoughtful
understanding
is as an ornament of plaster on a
polished wall.
18 Fences set on a high place will not stand
against the wind;
so a fearful heart in the imagination
of a fool will not stand against any
fear.

19 He who pricks the eye will make tears
fall.
He who pricks the heart makes it
show feeling.
20 Whoever casts a stone at birds scares
them away.
He who insults a friend will dissolve
friendship.
21 If you have drawn a sword against a
friend, don’t despair,
for there may be a way back.
22 If you have opened your mouth against
a friend, don’t be afraid,

† **22:9-10** Verses 9 and 10 are omitted by the best authorities.

for there may be reconciliation,
unless it is for insulting, arrogance,
disclosing of a secret, or a
treacherous blow—
for these things any friend will flee.

23 Gain trust with your neighbor in his
poverty,
that in his prosperity you may have
gladness.
Stay steadfast to him in the time of his
affliction,
that you may be heir with him in his
inheritance.‡
24 Before fire is the vapor and smoke of a
furnace,
so insults precede bloodshed.
25 I won't be ashamed to shelter a friend.
I won't hide myself from his face.
26 If any evil happens to me because of
him,
everyone who hears it will beware of
him.

27 Who will set a watch over my mouth,
and a seal of shrewdness upon my
lips,
that I may not fall from it, and that my
tongue may not destroy me?

23

1 O Lord, Father and Master of my life,
don't abandon me to their counsel.
Don't let me fall because of them.
2 Who will set scourges over my thought,
and a discipline of wisdom over my
heart,
that they spare me not for my errors,
and not overlook their sins?
3 Otherwise my errors might be
multiplied,
and my sins abound,
I fall before my adversaries,
and my enemy rejoice over me.†
4 O Lord, Father and God of my life,
don't give me a haughty eyes,‡
5 and turn away evil desire from me.§
6 Let neither gluttony nor lust overtake
me.
Don't give me over to a shameless
mind.

7 Listen, my children, to the discipline of
the mouth.
He who keeps it will not be caught.
8 The sinner will be overpowered through
his lips.
By them, the insulter and the
arrogant will stumble.
9 Don't accustom your mouth to an oath,
and don't be accustomed to naming
the Holy One,
10 for as a servant who is continually
scourged will not lack bruises,
so he also who swears and
continually utters the Name will
not be cleansed from sin.
11 A man of many oaths will be filled with
iniquity.
The scourge will not depart from his
house.
If he offends, his sin will be upon him.
If he disregards it, he has sinned
doubly.
If he has sworn falsely, he will not be
justified,
for his house will be filled with
calamities.

12 There is a manner of speech that is
clothed with death.
Let it not be found in the heritage of
Jacob,
for all these things will be far from
the godly,
and they will not wallow in sins.
13 Don't accustom your mouth to gross
rudeness,
for it involves sinful speech.
14 Remember your father and your
mother,
for you sit in the midst of great men,
that you be not forgetful before them,
and become a fool by your bad habit;
so you may wish that you had not been
born,
and curse the day of your birth.

‡ **22:23** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. † **23:3** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **23:4** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. § **23:5** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities.

15 A man who is accustomed to abusive
language
won't be corrected all the days of his
life.

16 Two sorts of people multiply sins,
and the third will bring wrath:
a hot passion, like a burning fire, will
not be quenched until it is
consumed;
a fornicator in the body of his flesh
will never cease until he has
burned out the fire.
17 All bread is sweet to a fornicator.
He will not cease until he dies.
18 A man who goes astray from his own
marriage bed
says in his heart, "Who sees me?
Darkness is around me, and the walls hide
me.
No one sees me. Of whom am I afraid?
The Most High will not remember my
sins."
19 The eyes of men are his terror.
He doesn't know that the eyes of the
Lord are ten thousand times
brighter than the sun,
seeing all the ways of men,
and looking into secret places.
20 All things were known to him before
they were created,
and also after they were completed.
21 This man will be punished in the streets
of the city.
He will be seized where he least
expects it.

22 So also is a wife who leaves her
husband,
and produces an heir by another
man.
23 For first, she was disobedient in the law
of the Most High.
Second, she trespassed against her
own husband.
Third, she played the adulteress in
fornication,
and had children by another man.
24 She shall be brought out into the
congregation.
Her punishment will extend to her
children.
25 Her children will not take root.
Her branches will bear no fruit.
26 She will leave her memory for a curse.
Her reproach won't be blotted out.
27 And those who are left behind will
know that there is nothing better
than the fear of the Lord,
and nothing sweeter than to heed the
commandments of the Lord.
28 †

24

1 Wisdom will praise her own soul,
and will proclaim her glory in the
midst of her people.
2 She will open her mouth in the
congregation of the Most High,
and proclaim her glory in the
presence of his power.
3 "I came out of the mouth of the Most
High,
and covered the earth as a mist.
4 I lived in high places,
and my throne is in the pillar of the
cloud.
5 Alone I surrounded the circuit of heaven,
and walked in the depth of the abyss.
6 In the waves of the sea, and in all the
earth,
and in every people and nation, I
obtained a possession.
7 With all these I sought rest.
In whose inheritance shall I lodge?
8 Then the Creator of all things gave me a
command.
He who created me made my tent to
rest,
and said, 'Let your dwelling be in
Jacob,
and your inheritance in Israel.'
9 He created me from the beginning,
before the ages.
For all ages, I will not cease to exist.
10 In the holy tabernacle, I ministered
before him.
So I was established in Zion.
11 In the beloved city, likewise he gave me
rest.
In Jerusalem was my domain.
12 I took root in a people that was honored,
even in the portion of the Lord's own
inheritance.

† **23:28** Verse 28 is omitted by the best authorities.

13 I was exalted like a cedar in Lebanon,
And like a cypress tree on the
mountains of Hermon.
14 I was exalted like a palm tree on the sea
shore,
like rose bushes in Jericho,
and like a fair olive tree in the plain.
I was exalted like a plane tree.
15 Like cinnamon and aspalathus, I have
given a scent to perfumes.
Like choice myrrh, I spread abroad a
pleasant fragrance,
like† galbanum, onycha, stacte,
and as the smell of frankincense in
the tabernacle.
16 Like the terebinth, I stretched out my
branches.
My branches are glorious and
graceful.
17 Like the vine, I put forth grace.
My flowers are the fruit of glory and
riches.
18 ‡

19 "Come to me, all you who desire me,
and be filled with my fruits.
20 For my memory is sweeter than honey,
and my inheritance than the
honeycomb.
21 Those who eat me will be hungry for
more.
Those who drink me will be thirsty
for more.
22 He who obeys me will not be ashamed.
Those who work with me will not sin."

23 All these things are the book of the
covenant of the Most High God,
the law which Moses commanded us
for an inheritance for the
assemblies of Jacob.
24 §
25 It is he who makes wisdom abundant,
as Pishon,
and as Tigris in the days of first fruits.
26 He makes understanding full as the
Euphrates,
and as the Jordan in the days of
harvest,
27 who makes instruction shine forth as
the light,
as Gihon in the days of vintage.
28 The first man didn't know her perfectly.
In like manner, the last has not
explored her.
29 For her thoughts are filled from the sea,
and her counsels from the great deep.

30 I came out as a canal stream from a
river,
and as an irrigation ditch into a
garden.
31 I said, "I will water my garden,
and will drench my garden bed."
Behold, my stream became a river,
and my river became a sea.
32 I will yet bring instruction to light as the
morning,
and will make these things clear from
far away.
33 I will continue to pour out teaching like
prophecy,
and leave it to all generations.
34 See that I have not labored for myself
only,
but for all those who diligently seek
wisdom.

25

1 I enjoy three things,
and they are beautiful before the
Lord and men:
the agreement of kindred,
the friendship of neighbors,
and a woman and her husband who
walk together in agreement.
2 But my soul hates three sorts of people,
and I am greatly offended at their life:
a poor man who is arrogant,
a rich man who is a liar,
and an old fool who is an adulterer.

3 If you gathered nothing in your youth,
how could you find anything in your
old age?
4 How beautiful a thing is judgment in the
gray-haired,
and for elders to know good counsel!
5 How beautiful is the wisdom of old men,

† **24:15** See Exodus 30:34. ‡ **24:18** Verse 18 is omitted by the best authorities. § **24:24** Verse 24 is omitted by the best authorities.

and understanding and counsel to
men who are in honor!
6 Much experience is the crown of the
aged.
Their glory is the fear of the Lord.

7 There are nine things that I have thought
of, and in my heart counted happy,
and the tenth I will utter with my
tongue:
a man who has joy with his children,
and a man who lives and sees the fall
of his enemies.
8 Happy is he who dwells with a wife of
understanding,
he who has not slipped with his
tongue,
and he who has not served a man
who is unworthy of him.
9 Happy is he who has found prudence,
and he who speaks in the ears of
those who listen.
10 How great is he who has found wisdom!
Yet there is none greater than one
who fears the Lord.
11 The fear of the Lord surpasses all things.
To whom shall he who holds it be
likened?
12 †

13 Any wound but a wound of the heart!
Any wickedness but the wickedness
of a woman!
14 Any calamity but a calamity from those
who hate me!
Any vengeance but the vengeance of
enemies!
15 There is no venom worse than a snake's
venom.
There is no wrath worse than an
enemy's wrath.

16 I would rather dwell with a lion and a
dragon
than keep house with a wicked
woman.
17 The wickedness of a woman changes
her appearance,
and darkens her countenance like
that of a bear.
18 Her husband will sit among his
neighbors,
and when he hears it, he sighs
bitterly.
19 All malice is small compared to the
malice of a woman.
Let the portion of a sinner fall on her.
20 As walking up a sandy hill is to the feet
of the aged,
so is a wife full of words to a quiet
man.
21 Don't be ensnared by a woman's beauty.
Don't desire a woman for her beauty.
22 There is anger, impudence, and great
reproach
if a woman supports her husband.
23 A wicked woman is abasement of heart,
sadness of countenance, and a
wounded heart.
A woman who won't make her husband
happy
is like hands that hang down, and
weak knees.
24 The beginning of sin came from a
woman.
Because of her, we all die.
25 Don't give water an outlet,
and don't give a wicked woman
freedom of speech.
26 If she doesn't go as you direct,
cut her away from your flesh.‡

26

1 Happy is the husband of a good wife.
The number of his days will be
doubled.
2 A faithful wife gives joy to her husband.
He will fulfill his years in peace.
3 A good wife is a great gift.
She will be given to those who fear
the Lord.
4 Whether a man is rich or poor,
a good heart makes a cheerful face at
all times.

5 Of three things my heart was afraid,
and concerning the fourth† kind I
made supplication:
The slander of a city, the assembly of
a mob, and a false accusation.
All these are more grievous than
death.

† **25:12** Verse 12 is omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **25:26** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. † **26:5** Gr. *countenance.*

6 A grief of heart and sorrow is a woman
who is jealous of another woman.
Her tongue-lashing makes it known to
all.
7 A wicked woman is like a chafing yoke.
He who takes hold of her is like one
who grasps a scorpion.
8 A drunken woman causes great wrath.
She will not cover her own shame.
9 The fornication of a woman is in the
lifting up of her eyes;
it will be known by her eyelids.
10 Keep strict watch on a headstrong
daughter,
lest she find liberty for herself, and
use it.
11 Watch out for an impudent eye,
and don't be surprised if it sins
against you.
12 She will open her mouth like a thirsty
traveller,
and drink from every water that is
near.
She will sit down at every post,
and open her quiver to any arrow.

13 The grace of a wife will delight her
husband.
Her knowledge will strengthen‡ his
bones.
14 A silent woman is a gift of the Lord.
There is nothing worth so much as a
well-instructed soul.
15 A modest woman is grace upon grace.
There are no scales that can weigh the
value of a self-controlled soul.
16 As the sun when it arises in the highest
places of the Lord,
so is the beauty of a good wife in her
well-organized home.
17 As the lamp that shines upon the holy
lampstand,
so is the beauty of the face on a
well-proportioned body.
18 As the golden pillars are upon a base of
silver,
so are beautiful feet with the breasts
of one who is steadfast.
19-27 §

28 For two things my heart is grieved,
and for the third anger comes upon
me:
a warrior who suffers for poverty,
men of understanding who are
counted as garbage,
and one who turns back from
righteousness to sin—
the Lord will prepare him for the
sword!

29 It is difficult for a merchant to keep
himself from wrong doing,
and for a retailer to be acquitted of
sin.

27

1 Many have sinned for profit.
He who seeks to multiply wealth will
turn his eye away.
2 As a nail will stick fast between the
joinings of stones,
so sin will thrust itself in between
buying and selling.
3 Unless a person holds on diligently to the
fear of the Lord,
his house will be overthrown quickly.

4 In the shaking of a sieve, the refuse
remains,
so does the filth of man in his
thoughts.
5 The furnace tests the potter's vessels;
so the test of a person is in his
thoughts.
6 The fruit of a tree discloses its
cultivation,
so is the utterance of the thought of a
person's heart.
7 Praise no man before you hear his
thoughts,
for this is how people are tested.

8 If you follow righteousness, you will
obtain it,
and put it on like a long robe of glory.
9 Birds will return to their own kind,
so truth will return to those who
practice it.
10 The lion lies in wait for prey.
So does sin for those who do evil.

‡ **26:13** or, fatten § **26:19-27** Verses 19-27 are omitted by the best authorities.

11 The discourse of a godly man is always wise,
but the fool changes like the moon.
12 Limit your time among people void of understanding,
but persevere among the thoughtful.
13 The talk of fools is offensive.
Their laughter is wantonly sinful.
14 Their talk with much swearing makes hair stand upright.
Their strife makes others plug their ears.
15 The strife of the proud leads to bloodshed.
Their abuse of each other is a grievous thing to hear.

16 He who reveals secrets destroys trust,
and will not find a close friend.
17 Love a friend, and keep faith with him;
but if you reveal his secrets,
you shall not follow him;
18 for as a man has destroyed his enemy,
so you have destroyed the friendship of your neighbor.
19 As a bird which you have released out of your hand,
so you have let your neighbor go, and you will not catch him again.
20 Don't pursue him, for he has gone far away,
and has escaped like a gazelle out of the snare.
21 For a wound may be bound up, and after abuse there may be reconciliation;
but he who reveals secrets is without hope.

22 One who winks the eye contrives evil things;
and those who know him will keep their distance.
23 When you are present, he will speak sweetly,
and will admire your words;
but afterward he will twist his speech and set a trap in your words.
24 I have hated many things, but nothing like him.
The Lord will hate him.
25 One who casts a stone straight up casts it on his own head.
A deceitful blow opens wounds.
26 He who digs a pit will fall into it.
He who sets a snare will be caught in it.
27 He who does evil things, they will roll back upon him,
and he will not know where they came from.
28 Mockery and reproach are from the arrogant.
Vengeance lies in wait for them like a lion.
29 Those who rejoice at the fall of the godly will be caught in a snare.
Anguish will consume them before they die.

30 Wrath and anger, these also are abominations.
A sinner will possess them.

28

1 He who takes vengeance will find vengeance from the Lord,
and he will surely make his sins firm.
2 Forgive your neighbor the hurt that he has done,
and then your sins will be pardoned when you pray.
3 Does anyone harbor anger against another
and expect healing from the Lord?
4 Upon a man like himself he has no mercy,
and does he make supplication for his own sins?
5 He himself, being flesh, nourishes wrath.
Who will make atonement for his sins?
6 Remember your last end, and stop enmity.
Remember corruption and death, and be true to the commandments.
7 Remember the commandments, and don't be angry with your neighbor.
Remember the covenant of the Highest, and overlook ignorance.

8 Abstain from strife, and you will diminish your sins,

for a passionate man will kindle
strife.
9 A man who is a sinner will trouble
friends
and sow discord among those who
are at peace.
10 As is the fuel of the fire, so it will burn;
and as the stoutness of the strife is, so
it will burn.
As is the strength of the man, so will be his
wrath;
and as is his wealth, so he will exalt
his anger.
11 A contention begun in haste kindles a
fire;
and hasty fighting sheds blood.

12 If you blow on a spark, it will burn;
and if you spit upon it, it will be
quenched.
Both of these come out of your mouth.

13 Curse the whisperer and
double-tongued,
for he has destroyed many who were
at peace.
14 A slanderer has shaken many,
and dispersed them from nation to
nation.
It has pulled down strong cities
and overthrown the houses of great
men.
15 A slanderer has cast out brave women
and deprived them of their labors.
16 He who listens to it will not find rest,
nor will he live quietly.
17 The stroke of a whip makes a mark in
the flesh,
but the stroke of a tongue will break
bones.
18 Many have fallen by the edge of the
sword,
yet not so many as those who have
fallen because of the tongue.
19 Happy is he who is sheltered from it,
who has not passed through its wrath,
who has not drawn its yoke,
and has not been bound with its
bands.
20 For its yoke is a yoke of iron,
and its bands are bands of brass.
21 Its death is an evil death,
and Hades is better than it.
22 It will not have rule over godly men.
They will not be burned in its flame.
23 Those who forsake the Lord will fall
into it.
It will burn among them, and won't
be quenched.
It will be sent against them like a lion.
It will destroy them like a leopard.
24 As you hedge your possession about
with thorns,
and secure your silver and your gold,
25 so make a balance and a weight for
your words,
and make a door and a bar for your
mouth.
26 Take heed lest you slip with it,
lest you fall before one who lies in
wait.

29

1 He who shows mercy will lend to his
neighbor.
He who strengthens him with his
hand keeps the commandments.
2 Lend to your neighbor in time of his
need.
Repay your neighbor on time.
3 Confirm your word, and keep faith with
him;
and at all seasons you will find what
you need.
4 Many have considered a loan to be a
windfall,
and have given trouble to those who
helped them.
5 Until he has received, he will kiss a
man's hands.
For his neighbor's money he will
speak submissively.
Then when payment is due, he will
prolong the time,
return excuses, and complain about
the season.
6 If he prevails, the creditor will hardly
receive half;
and he will count it as a windfall.
If not, he has deprived him of his money,
and he has gotten him for an enemy
without cause.
He will pay him with cursing and railing.
Instead of honor, he will pay him
disgrace.

7 Many on account of fraud have turned
away.
They are afraid of being defrauded
for nothing.
8 However be patient with a man in poor
estate.
Don't keep him waiting for your alms.
9 Help a poor man for the
commandment's sake.
According to his need don't send him
empty away.
10 Lose your money for a brother and a
friend.
Don't let it rust under a stone and be
lost.
11 Allocate your treasure according to the
commandments of the Most High
and it will profit you more than gold.
12 Store up almsgiving in your
store-chambers
and it will deliver you out of all
affliction.
13 It will fight for you against your enemy
better than a mighty shield and a
ponderous spear.

14 A good man will be surety for his
neighbor.
He who has lost shame will fail him.
15 Don't forget the kindness of your
guarantor,
for he has given his life for you.
16 A sinner will waste the property of his
guarantor.
17 He who is thankless will fail him
who delivered him.
18 Being surety has undone many who
were prospering
and shaken them as a wave of the sea.
It has driven mighty men from their
homes.
They wandered among foreign
nations.
19 A sinner who falls into suretiship and
undertakes contracts for work
will fall into lawsuits.
20 Help your neighbor according to your
power,
and be careful not to fall yourself.

21 The essentials of life are water, bread,
a garment, and a house for privacy.
22 Better is the life of a poor man under a
shelter of logs
than sumptuous fare in another
man's house.
23 With little or with much, be well
satisfied.†
24 It is a miserable life to go from house to
house.
Where you are a guest, you dare not
open your mouth.
25 You will entertain, serve drinks, and
have no thanks.
In addition to this, you will hear bitter
words.
26 "Come here, you sojourner, set a table,
and if you have anything in your
hand, feed me with it."
27 "Leave, you sojourner, for an honored
guest is here.
My brother has come to be my guest. I
need my house."
28 These things are grievous to a man of
understanding:
The scolding about lodging and the
insults of creditors.

30

1 He who loves his son will continue to lay
stripes upon him,
that he may have joy from him in the
end.
2 He who chastises his son will have profit
from him,
and will brag about him among his
acquaintances.
3 He who teaches his son will provoke his
enemy to jealousy.
Before friends, he will rejoice in him.
4 His father dies, and is as though he had
not died;
for he has left one behind him like
himself.
5 In his life, he saw his son and rejoiced.
When he died, it was without regret.
6 He left behind him an avenger against
his enemies,
and one to repay kindness to his
friends.

7 He who makes too much of his son will
bind up his wounds.

† **29:23** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities.

His heart will be troubled at every
cry.
8 An unbroken horse becomes stubborn.
An unrestrained son becomes
headstrong.
9 Pamper your child, and he will make you
afraid.
Play with him, and he will grieve you.
10 Don't laugh with him, lest you have
sorrow with him,
and you gnash your teeth in the end.
11 Give him no liberty in his youth,
and don't ignore his follies.†
12 ‡Bow down his neck in his youth,
and beat him on the sides while he is
a child,
lest he become stubborn, and be
disobedient to you,
and there be sorrow to your soul.§
13 Chastise your son, and give him work,
lest his shameless behavior be an
offense to you.

14 Better is a poor man who is healthy and
fit,
than a rich man who is afflicted in his
body.
15 Health and fitness are better than all
gold,
and a strong body better than wealth
without measure.
16 There is no wealth better than health of
body.
There is no gladness above the joy of
the heart.
17 Death is better than a bitter life,
and eternal rest than a continual
sickness.

18 Good things poured out upon a mouth
that is closed
are like food offerings laid upon a
grave.
19 What does an offering profit an idol?
For it can't eat or smell.
So is he who is punished by the Lord,
20 seeing with his eyes and groaning,
like a eunuch embracing a virgin and
groaning.

21 Don't give your soul to sorrow.
Don't afflict yourself deliberately.
22 Gladness of heart is the life of a man.
Cheerfulness of a man lengthens his
days.
23 Love your own soul, and comfort your
heart.
Remove sorrow far from you,
for sorrow has destroyed many,
and there is no profit in it.
24 Envy and wrath shorten life.
Anxiety brings old age before its time.
25 Those who are cheerful and merry
will benefit from their food.

31

1 Wakefulness that comes from riches
consumes the flesh,
and anxiety about it takes away sleep.
2 Wakeful anxiety will crave slumber.
In a severe disease, sleep will be
broken.

3 A rich man toils in gathering money
together.
When he rests, he is filled with his
good things.
4 A poor man toils in lack of substance.
When he rests, he becomes needy.
5 He who loves gold won't be justified.
He who follows destruction will
himself have his fill of it.
6 Many have been given over to ruin for
the sake of gold.
Their destruction meets them face to
face.
7 It is a stumbling block to those who
sacrifice to it.
Every fool will be taken by it.
8 Blessed is the rich person who is found
blameless,
and who doesn't go after gold.
9 Who is he, that we may call him blessed?
For he has done wonderful things
among his people.
10 Who has been tried by it, and found
perfect?
Then let him boast.
Who has had the power to transgress, and
has not transgressed?
And to do evil, and has not done it?

† **30:11** This line and the previous two lines are absent from some older MSS. ‡ **30:12** These three lines are absent from the oldest MSS. § **30:12** These three lines are absent from the oldest MSS.

11 His prosperity will be made sure.
The congregation will proclaim his alms.

12 Do you sit at a great table? Don't be greedy there.
Don't say, "There is a lot of food on it!"
13 Remember that a greedy eye is a wicked thing.
What has been created more greedy than an eye?
Therefore it sheds tears from every face.
14 Don't stretch your hand wherever it looks.
Don't thrust yourself with it into the dish.
15 Consider your neighbor's feelings by your own.
Be discreet in every point.
16 Eat like a human being those things which are set before you.
Don't eat greedily, lest you be hated.
17 Be first to stop for manners' sake.
Don't be insatiable, lest you offend.
18 And if you sit among many,
Don't reach out your hand before them.

19 How sufficient to a well-mannered man is a very little.
He doesn't breathe heavily in his bed.
20 Healthy sleep comes from moderate eating.
He rises early, and his wits are with him.
The pain of wakefulness, colic,
and griping are with an insatiable man.
21 And if you have been forced to eat,
rise up in the middle of it, and you shall have rest.
22 Hear me, my son, and don't despise me,
and in the end you will appreciate my words.
In all your works be skillful,
and no disease will come to you.

23 People bless him who is liberal with his food.
The testimony of his excellence will be believed.
24 The city will murmur at him who is a stingy with his food.
The testimony of his stinginess will be accurate.

25 Don't show yourself valiant in wine,
for wine has destroyed many.
26 The furnace tests the temper of steel by dipping;
so does wine test hearts in the quarreling of the proud.
27 Wine is as good as life to men,
if you drink it in moderation.
What life is there to a man who is without wine?
It has been created to make men glad.
28 Wine drunk in season and in moderation
is joy of heart and gladness of soul:
29 Wine drunk excessively is bitterness of soul,
with provocation and conflict.
30 Drunkenness increases the rage of a fool to his hurt.
It diminishes strength and adds wounds.

31 Don't rebuke your neighbor at a banquet of wine.
Don't despise him in his mirth.
Don't speak a word of reproach to him.
Don't distress him by making demands of him.

32

1 Have they made you ruler of a feast?
Don't be lifted up.
Be among them as one of them.
Take care of them first, and then sit down.
2 And when you have done all your duties, take your place,
that you may be gladdened on their account,
and receive a wreath for your good service.

3 Speak, you who are older, for it's your right, but with sound knowledge;
and don't interrupt the music.
4 Don't pour out talk where there is a performance of music.

Don't display your wisdom at the
wrong time.
5 As a ruby signet in a setting of gold,
so is a music concert at a wine
banquet.
6 As an emerald signet in a work of gold,
so is musical melody with pleasant
wine.

7 Speak, young man, if you are obliged to,
but no more than twice, and only if
asked.
8 Sum up your speech, many things in few
words.
Be as one who knows and yet holds
his tongue.
9 When among great men, don't behave as
their equal.
When another is speaking, don't
babble.

10 Lightning speeds before thunder.
Approval goes before one who is
modest.
11 Rise up in good time, and don't be last.
Go home quickly and don't loiter
12 Amuse yourself there and do what is in
your heart.
Don't sin by proud speech.
13 For these things bless your Maker,
who gives you to drink freely of his
good things.

14 He who fears the Lord will receive
discipline.
Those who seek him early will find
favor.
15 He who seeks the law shall be filled
with it,
but the hypocrite will stumble at it.
16 Those who fear the Lord will find true
judgment,
and will kindle righteous acts like a
light.
17 A sinful man shuns reproof,
and will find a judgment according to
his will.

18 A sensible person won't neglect a
thought.
An insolent and proud man won't
crouch in fear,
even after he has done a thing by
himself without counsel.
19 Do nothing without counsel,
but when you have acted, don't regret
it.
20 Don't go in a way of conflict.
Don't stumble in stony places.
21 Don't be overconfident on a smooth
road.
22 Beware of your own children.
23 In every work guard your own soul,
for this is the keeping of the
commandments.

24 He who believes the law gives heed to
the commandment.
He who trusts in the Lord will suffer
no loss.

33

1 No evil will happen to him who fears the
Lord,
but in trials once and again he will
deliver him.
2 A wise man will not hate the law,
but he who is a hypocrite about it is
like a boat in a storm.
3 A man of understanding will put his
trust in the law.
And the law is faithful to him, as
when one asks a divine oracle.

4 Prepare your speech, and so you will be
heard.
Bind up instruction, and make your
answer.
5 The heart of a fool is like a cartwheel.
His thoughts are like a rolling axle.
6 A stallion horse is like a mocking friend.
He neighs under every one who sits
upon him.

7 Why does one day excel another,
when all the light of every day in the
year is from the sun?
8 They were distinguished by the Lord's
knowledge,
and he varied seasons and feasts.
9 Some of them he exalted and hallowed,
and some of them he has made
ordinary days.
10 And all men are from the ground.
Adam was created from dust.

11 In the abundance of his knowledge the Lord distinguished them,
and made their ways different.
12 Some of them he blessed and exalted,
and some of them he made holy and brought near to himself.
Some of them he cursed and brought low,
and overthrew them from their place.
13 As the clay of the potter in his hand,
all his ways are according to his good pleasure,
so men are in the hand of him who made them,
to give to them according to his judgment.

14 Good is the opposite of evil,
and life is the opposite of death;
so† the sinner is the opposite of the godly.
15 Look upon all the works of the Most High like this,
they come in pairs, one against another.

16 I was the last on watch,
like one who gleans after the grape gatherers.
17 By the Lord's blessing I arrived before them,
and filled my winepress like one who gathers grapes.
18 Consider that I labored not for myself alone,
but for all those who seek instruction.
19 Hear me, you great men of the people,
and listen with your ears, you rulers of the congregation.

20 To son and wife, to brother and friend,
don't give power over yourself while you live,
and don't give your goods to another,
lest you regret it and must ask for them.
21 While you still live and breath is in you,
don't give yourself over to anybody.
22 For it is better that your children should ask from you
than that you should look to the hand of your children.
23 Excel in all your works.
Don't bring a stain on your honor.
24 In the day that you end the days of your life,
in the time of death, distribute your inheritance.

25 Fodder, a stick, and burdens are for a donkey.
Bread, discipline, and work are for a servant.
26 Set your slave to work, and you will find rest.
Leave his hands idle, and he will seek liberty.
27 Yoke and whip will bow the neck.
For an evil slave there are racks and tortures.
28 Send him to labor, that he not be idle,
for idleness teaches much mischief.
29 Set him to work, as is fit for him.
If he doesn't obey, make his fetters heavy.
30 Don't be excessive toward any.
Do nothing unjust.

31 If you have a slave, treat him like yourself,
because you have bought him with blood.
32 If you have a slave, treat him like yourself.
For like your own soul, you will need him.
If you treat him ill, and he departs and runs away,
33 which way will you go to seek him?

34

1 Vain and false hopes are for a man void of understanding.
Dreams give wings to fools.
2 As one who grasps at a shadow and follows after the wind,
so is he who sets his mind on dreams.
3 The vision of dreams is a reflection,
the likeness of a face near a face.
4 From an unclean thing what can be cleansed?

† **33:14** A line of this verse is here omitted by the best authorities.

From that which is false what can be true?
5 Divinations, and soothsayings, and dreams, are vain.
The heart has fantasies like a woman in labor.
6 If they are not sent in a visitation from the Most High,
don't give your heart to them.
7 For dreams have led many astray.
They have failed by putting their hope in them.
8 Without lying the law will be fulfilled.
Wisdom is complete in a faithful mouth.

9 A well-instructed man knows many things.
He who has much experience will declare understanding.
10 He who has no experience knows few things.
But he who has traveled increases cleverness.
11 I have seen many things in my travels.
My understanding is more than my words.
12 I was often in danger even to death.
I was preserved because of these experiences.
13 The spirit of those who fear the Lord will live,
for their hope is in him who saves them.
14 Whoever fears the Lord won't be afraid, and won't be a coward,
for he is his hope.
15 Blessed is the soul of him who fears the Lord.
To whom does he give heed? Who is his support?
16 The eyes of the Lord are on those who love him,
a mighty protection and strong support,
a cover from the hot blast, a shade from the noonday sun,
a guard from stumbling, and a help from falling.
17 He raises up the soul, and enlightens the eyes.
He gives health, life, and blessing.
18 He who sacrifices a thing wrongfully gotten, his offering is made in mockery.
The mockeries of wicked men are not acceptable.
19 The Most High has no pleasure in the offerings of the ungodly,
Neither is he pacified for sins by the multitude of sacrifices.
20 Like one who kills a son before his father's eyes
is he who brings a sacrifice from the goods of the poor.
21 The bread of the needy is the life of the poor.
He who deprives him of it is a man of blood.
22 Like one who murders his neighbor is he who takes away his living.
Like a shedder of blood is he who deprives a hireling of his hire.

23 When one builds, and another pulls down,
what profit do they have but toil?
24 When one prays, and another curses,
whose voice will the Lord listen to?
25 He who washes himself after touching a dead body, and touches it again,
what does he gain by his washing?
26 Even so a man fasting for his sins,
and going again, and doing the same,
who will listen to his prayer?
What profit does he have in his humiliation?

35

1 He who keeps the law multiplies offerings.
He who heeds the commandments sacrifices a peace offering.
2 He who returns a kindness offers fine flour.
He who gives alms sacrifices a thank offering.
3 To depart from wickedness pleases the Lord.
To depart from unrighteousness is an atoning sacrifice.
4 See that you don't appear in the presence of the Lord empty.

5 For all these things are done because
of the commandment.
6 The offering of the righteous enriches
the altar.
The sweet fragrance of it is before the
Most High.
7 The sacrifice of a righteous man is
acceptable.
It won't be forgotten.
8 Glorify the Lord with generosity.
Don't reduce the first fruits of your
hands.
9 In every gift show a cheerful
countenance,
And dedicate your tithe with gladness.
10 Give to the Most High according as he
has given.
As your hand has found, give
generously.
11 For the Lord repays,
and he will repay you sevenfold.

12 Don't plan to bribe him with gifts, for he
will not receive them.
Don't set your mind on an
unrighteous sacrifice,
For the Lord is the judge,
and with him is no respect of persons.
13 He won't accept any person against a
poor man.
He will listen to the prayer of him
who is wronged.
14 He will in no way despise the
supplication of the fatherless
or the widow, when she pours out her
tale.
15 Don't the tears of the widow run down
her cheek?
Isn't her cry against him who has
caused them to fall?
16 He who serves God according to his
good pleasure will be accepted.
His supplication will reach to the
clouds.
17 The prayer of the humble pierces the
clouds.
until it comes near, he will not be
comforted.
He won't depart until the Most High visits
and he judges righteously and
executes judgment.
18 And the Lord will not be slack, neither
will he be patient toward them,
until he has crushed the loins of the
unmerciful.
He will repay vengeance to the heathen
until he has taken away the multitude
of the arrogant
and broken in pieces the sceptres of
the unrighteous,
19 until he has rendered to every man
according to his deeds,
and repaid the works of men
according to their plans,
until he has judged the cause of his
people,
and he will make them rejoice in his
mercy.
20 Mercy is as welcome in the time of his
affliction,
as clouds of rain in the time of
drought.

36

1 Have mercy upon us, O Lord the God of
all, and look at us with favor;
2 and send your fear upon all the
nations.†
3 Lift up your hand against the foreign
nations
and let them see your mighty power.
4 As you showed your holiness in us
before them,
so be magnified in them before us.
5 Let them know you, as we also have
known you,
that there is no God but only you, O
God.
6 Show new signs, and work various
wonders.
Glorify your hand and your right
arm.‡
7 Raise up indignation and pour out wrath.
Take away the adversary and destroy
the enemy.
8 Hasten the time and remember your
oath.
Let them declare your mighty works.
9 Let him who escapes be devoured by
raging fire.

† **36:2** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **36:6** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities.

May those who harm your people
find destruction.
10 Crush the heads of the rulers of the enemies
who say, “There is no one but ourselves.”
11 Gather all the tribes of Jacob together,
and§ take them for your inheritance,
as from the beginning.
12 O Lord, have mercy upon the people that is called by your name,
and upon Israel, whom you likened to a firstborn.
13 Have compassion upon the city of your sanctuary,
Jerusalem, the place of your rest.
14 Fill Zion. Exalt your oracles
and fill your people with your glory.
15 Give testimony to those who were your creatures in the beginning,
and fulfill the prophecies that have been spoken in your name.
16 Reward those who wait for you,
and men will put their trust in your prophets.
17 Listen, O Lord, to the prayer of your servants,
according to the blessing of Aaron concerning your people;
and all those who are on the earth will know
that you are the Lord, the† eternal God.

18 The belly will eat any food,
but one food is better than another.
19 The mouth tastes meats taken in hunting,
so does an understanding heart detect false speech.
20 A contrary heart will cause heaviness.
A man of experience will pay him back.
21 A woman will receive any man,
but one daughter is better than another.
22 The beauty of a woman cheers the countenance.
A man desires nothing more.
23 If kindness and humility are on her tongue,
her husband is not like other sons of men.
24 He who gets a wife gets his richest treasure,
a help meet for him and a pillar of support.
25 Where no hedge is, the property will be plundered.
He who has no wife will mourn as he wanders.
26 For who would trust a nimble robber who skips from city to city?
Even so, who would trust a man who has no nest, and lodges wherever he finds himself at nightfall?

37

1 Every friend will say, “I also am his friend”;
but there is a friend which is only a friend in name.
2 Isn’t there a grief in it even to death
when a companion and friend is turned into an enemy?
3 O wicked imagination, why were you formed
to cover the dry land with deceit?
4 There is a companion who rejoices in the gladness of a friend,
but in time of affliction will be against him.
5 There is a companion who for the belly’s sake labors with his friend,
yet in the face of battle will carry his buckler.
6 Don’t forget a friend in your soul.
Don’t be unmindful of him in your riches.

7 Every counselor extols counsel,
but some give counsel in their own interest.
8 Let your soul beware of a counselor,
and know in advance what is his interest
(for he will take counsel for himself),
lest he cast the lot against you,
9 and say to you, “Your way is good.”
Then he will stand near you, to see what will happen to you.

§ **36:11** The ancient authorities read *I took them for my inheritance:* but the Greek text is here very confused.
† **36:17** Gr. *God of the ages.*

10 Don't take counsel with one who looks
askance at you.
Hide your counsel from those who
are jealous of you.
11 Don't consult with a woman about her
rival,
with a coward about war,
with a merchant about business,
with a buyer about selling,
with an envious man about
thankfulness,
with an unmerciful man about
kindliness,
with a sluggard about any kind of
work,
with a hireling in your house about
finishing his work,
or with an idle servant about much
business.
Pay no attention to these in any
matter of counsel.
12 But rather be continually with a godly
man,
whom you know to be a keeper of the
commandments,
who in his soul is as your own soul,
and who will grieve with you, if you
fail.
13 Make the counsel of your heart stand,
for there is no one more faithful to
you than it.
14 For a man's soul is sometimes inclined
to inform him
better than seven watchmen who sit
on high on a watch-tower.
15 Above all this ask the Most High
that he may direct your way in truth.

16 Let reason be the beginning of every
work.
Let counsel go before every action.
17 As a token of the changing of the heart,
18 four kinds of things rise up:
good and evil, life and death.
That which rules over them
continually is the tongue.
19 There is one who is clever and the
instructor of many,
and yet is unprofitable to his own
soul.
20 There is one who is subtle in words, and
is hated.
He will be destitute of all food.
21 For grace was not given to him from the
Lord,
because he is deprived of all wisdom.
22 There is one who is wise to his own soul;
and the fruits of his understanding
are trustworthy in the mouth.
23 A wise man will instruct his own people.
The fruits of his understanding are
trustworthy.
24 A wise man will be filled with blessing.
All those who see him will call him
happy.
25 The life of a man is counted by days.
The days of Israel are innumerable.
26 The wise man will inherit confidence
among his people.
His name will live forever.

27 My son, test your soul in your life.
See what is evil for it, and don't give
in to it.
28 For not all things are profitable for all
men.
Not every soul has pleasure in
everything.
29 Don't be insatiable in any luxury.
Don't be greedy in the things that you
eat.
30 For overeating brings disease,
and gluttony causes nausea.
31 Because of gluttony, many have
perished,
but he who takes heed shall prolong
his life.

38

1 Honor a physician according to your
need with the honors due to him,
for truly the Lord has created him.
2 For healing comes from the Most High,
and he shall receive a gift from the
king.
3 The skill of the physician will lift up his
head.
He will be admired in the sight of
great men.
4 The Lord created medicines out of the
earth.
A prudent man will not despise them.
5 Wasn't water made sweet with wood,
that its power might be known?
6 He gave men skill

that he might be glorified in his
marvelous works.
7 With them he heals
and takes away pain.
8 With these, the pharmacist makes a
mixture.
God's works won't be brought to an
end.
From him, peace is upon the face of
the earth.

9 My son, in your sickness don't be
negligent,
but pray to the Lord, and he will heal
you.
10 Put away wrong doing, and direct your
hands in righteousness.
Cleanse your heart from all sin.
11 Give a sweet savor and a memorial of
fine flour,
and pour oil on your offering,
according to your means.
12 Then give place to the physician, for
truly the Lord has created him.
Don't let him leave you, for you need
him.
13 There is a time when recovery is in
their hands.
14 For they also shall ask the Lord
to prosper them in diagnosis and in
healing for the maintenance of life.
15 He who sins before his Maker,
let him fall into the hands of the
physician.

16 My son, let your tears fall over the dead,
and as one who suffers grievously,
begin lamentation.
Wind up his body with due honor.
Don't neglect his burial.
17 Make bitter weeping and make
passionate wailing.
Let your mourning be according to
his merit,
for one day or two, lest you be spoken
evil of;
and so be comforted for your sorrow.
18 For from sorrow comes death.
Sorrow of heart saps one's strength.
19 In calamity, sorrow also remains.
A poor man's life is grievous to the
heart.
20 Don't give your heart to sorrow.
Put it away, remembering the end.
21 Don't forget it, for there is no returning
again.
You do him no good, and you would
harm yourself.
22 Remember his end, for so also will
yours be:
yesterday for him, and today for you.
23 When the dead is at rest, let his
remembrance rest.
Be comforted for him when his spirit
departs from him.

24 The wisdom of the scribe comes by the
opportunity of leisure.
He who has little business can
become wise.
25 How could he become wise who holds
the plow,
who glories in the shaft of the goad,
who drives oxen and is occupied in
their labors,
and who mostly talks about bulls?
26 He will set his heart upon turning his
furrows.
His lack of sleep is to give his heifers
their fodder.
27 So is every craftsman and master
artisan
who passes his time by night as by
day,
those who cut engravings of signets.
His diligence is to make great variety.
He sets his heart to preserve likeness
in his portraiture,
and is careful to finish his work.
28 So too is the smith sitting by the anvil
and considering the unwrought iron.
The smoke of the fire will waste his flesh.
He toils in the heat of the furnace.
The noise of the hammer deafens his ear.
His eyes are upon the pattern of the
object.
He will set his heart upon perfecting his
works.
He will be careful to adorn them
perfectly.
29 So is the potter sitting at his work
and turning the wheel around with
his feet,
who is always anxiously set at his
work.

He produces his handiwork in
quantity.
30 He will fashion the clay with his arm
and will bend its strength in front of
his feet.
He will apply his heart to finish the
glazing.
He will be careful to clean the kiln.

31 All these put their trust in their hands.
Each becomes skillful in his own
work.
32 Without these no city would be
inhabited.
Men wouldn't reside as foreigners or
walk up and down there.
33 They won't be sought for in the council
of the people.
They won't mount on high in the
assembly.
They won't sit on the seat of the judge.
They won't understand the covenant
of judgment.
Neither will they declare instruction
and judgment.
They won't be found where parables
are.
34 But they will maintain the fabric of the
age.
Their prayer is in the handiwork of
their craft.

39

1 Not so he who has applied his soul
and meditates in the law of the Most
High.
He will seek out the wisdom of all the
ancients
and will be occupied with prophecies.
2 He will keep the sayings of the men of
renown
and will enter in amidst the subtleties
of parables.
3 He will seek out the hidden meaning of
proverbs
and be conversant in the dark sayings
of parables.
4 He will serve among great men
and appear before him who rules.
He will travel through the land of foreign
nations,
for he has learned what is good and
evil among men.
5 He will apply his heart to return early to
the Lord who made him,
and will make supplication before the
Most High,
and will open his mouth in prayer,
and will ask for pardon for his sins.

6 If the great Lord wills,
he will be filled with the spirit of
understanding;
he will pour forth the words of his
wisdom
and in prayer give thanks to the Lord.
7 He will direct his counsel and
knowledge,
and he will meditate in his secrets.
8 He will show the instruction which he
has been taught
and will glory in the law of the
covenant of the Lord.
9 Many will commend his understanding.
So long as the world endures, it won't
be blotted out.
His memory won't depart.
His name will live from generation to
generation.
10 Nations will declare his wisdom.
The congregation will proclaim his
praise.
11 If he continues, he will leave a greater
name than a thousand.
If he finally rests, it is enough for him.

12 Yet more I will utter, which I have
thought about.
I am filled like the full moon.
13 Listen to me, you holy children,
and bud forth like a rose growing by a
brook of water.
14 Give a sweet fragrance like
frankincense.
Put forth flowers like a lily.
Scatter a sweet smell and sing a song
of praise.
Bless the Lord for all his works!
15 Magnify his name
and give utterance to his praise
with the songs on your lips and with
harps!
Say this when you utter his praise:

16 All the works of the Lord are
exceedingly good,
and every command will be done in
its time.
17 No one can say, “What is this?” “Why is
that?”
for at the proper time they will all be
sought out.
At his word, the waters stood as a heap,
as did the reservoirs of water at the
word of his mouth.
18 At his command all his good pleasure is
fulfilled.
There is no one who can hinder his
salvation.
19 The works of all flesh are before him.
It’s impossible to be hidden from his
eyes.
20 He sees from everlasting to everlasting.
There is nothing too wonderful for
him.
21 No one can say, “What is this?” “Why is
that?”
for all things are created for their
own uses.

22 His blessing covered the dry land as a
river
and saturated it as a flood.
23 As he has made the waters salty,
so the heathen will inherit his wrath.
24 His ways are plain to the holy.
They are stumbling blocks to the
wicked.
25 Good things are created from the
beginning for the good.
So are evil things for sinners.
26 The main things necessary for the life of
man
are water, fire, iron, salt,
wheat flour, and honey, milk,
the blood of the grape, oil, and
clothing.
27 All these things are for good to the
godly,
but for sinners, they will be turned
into evils.

28 There are winds that are created for
vengeance,
and in their fury they lay on their
scourges heavily.
In the time of reckoning, they pour out
their strength,
and will appease the wrath of him
who made them.
29 Fire, hail, famine, and death—
all these are created for vengeance—
30 wild beasts’ teeth, scorpions,
adders,
and a sword punishing the ungodly to
destruction.
31 They will rejoice in his commandment,
and will be made ready upon earth
when needed.
In their seasons, they won’t disobey
his command.

32 Therefore from the beginning I was
convinced,
and I thought it through and left it in
writing:
33 All the works of the Lord are good.
He will supply every need in its time.
34 No one can say, “This is worse than
that,”
for they will all be well approved in
their time.
35 Now with all your hearts and voices,
sing praises
and bless the Lord’s name!

40

1 Great travail is created for every man.
A heavy yoke is upon the sons of
Adam,
from the day of their coming forth
from their mother’s womb,
until the day for their burial in the
mother of all things.
2 The expectation of things to come, and
the day of death,
trouble their thoughts, and cause fear
in their hearts.
3 From him who sits on a throne of glory,
even to him who is humbled in earth
and ashes,
4 from him who wears purple and a
crown,
even to him who is clothed in burlap,
5 there is wrath, jealousy, trouble, unrest,
fear of death, anger, and strife.
In the time of rest upon his bed,
his night sleep changes his
knowledge.
6 He gets little or no rest,

and afterward in his sleep, as in a day
of keeping watch,
he is troubled in the vision of his
heart,
as one who has escaped from the
front of battle.
7 In the very time of his deliverance, he
awakens,
and marvels that the fear is nothing.

8 To all creatures, human and animal,
and upon sinners sevenfold more,
9 come death, bloodshed, strife,
sword,
calamities, famine, suffering, and
plague.
10 All these things were created for the
wicked,
and because of them the flood came.
11 All things that are of the earth turn to
the earth again.
All things that are of the waters
return into the sea.

12 All bribery and injustice will be blotted
out.
Good faith will stand forever.
13 The goods of the unjust will be dried up
like a river,
and like a great thunder in rain will
go off in noise.
14 In opening his hands, a man will be
made glad;
so lawbreakers will utterly fail.
15 The children of the ungodly won't grow
many branches,
and are as unhealthy roots on a sheer
rock.
16 The reeds by every water or river bank
will be plucked up before all grass.
17 Kindness is like a garden of blessings.
Almsgiving endures forever.

18 The life of one who labors and is
content will be made sweet.
He who finds a treasure is better than
both.
19 Children and the building of a city
establish a name.
A blameless wife is better than both.
20 Wine and music rejoice the heart.
The love of wisdom is better than
both.
21 The pipe and the lute make pleasant
melody.
A pleasant tongue is better than both.
22 Your eye desires grace and beauty,
but the green shoots of grain more
than both.
23 A friend and a companion is always
welcome,
and a wife with her husband is better
than both.
24 Relatives and helpers are for a time of
affliction,
but almsgiving rescues better than
both.
25 Gold and silver will make the foot stand
sure,
and counsel is esteemed better than
both.
26 Riches and strength will lift up the
heart.
The fear of the Lord is better than
both.
There is nothing lacking in the fear of the
Lord.
In it, there is no need to seek help.
27 The fear of the Lord is like a garden of
blessing
and covers a man more than any
glory.

28 My son, don't lead a beggar's life.
It is better to die than to beg.
29 A man who looks to the table of another,
his life is not to be considered a life.
He will pollute his soul with another
person's food,
but a wise and well-instructed person
will beware of that.
30 Begging will be sweet in the mouth of
the shameless,
but it kindles a fire in his belly.

41

1 O death, how bitter is the memory of you
to a man who is at peace in his
possessions,
to the man who has nothing to
distract him and has prosperity in
all things,
and who still has strength to enjoy
food!

2 O death, your sentence is acceptable to a
man who is needy and who fails in
strength,
who is in extreme old age, is
distracted about all things,
is perverse, and has lost patience!
3 Don't be afraid of the sentence of death.
Remember those who have been
before you and who come after.
This is the sentence from the Lord over all
flesh.
4 And why do you refuse when it is the
good pleasure of the Most High?
Whether life lasts ten, or a hundred, or a
thousand years,
there is no inquiry about life in
Hades.†

5 The children of sinners are abominable
children
and they frequent the dwellings of
the ungodly.
6 The inheritance of sinners' children will
perish
and with their posterity will be a
perpetual disgrace.
7 Children will complain of an ungodly
father,
because they suffer disgrace because
of him.
8 Woe to you, ungodly men,
who have forsaken the law of the
Most High God!‡
9 If you are born, you will be born to a
curse.
If you die, a curse will be your
portion.
10 All things that are of the earth will go
back to the earth;
so the ungodly will go from a curse to
perdition.

11 The mourning of men is about their
bodies;
but the evil name of sinners will be
blotted out.
12 Have regard for your name,
for it continues with you longer than
a thousand great treasures of gold.
13 A good life has its number of days,
but a good name continues forever.

14 My children, follow instruction in
peace.
But wisdom that is hidden and a
treasure that is not seen,
what benefit is in them both?
15 Better is a man who hides his
foolishness
than a man who hides his wisdom.
16 Therefore show respect for my words;
for it is not good to retain every kind
of shame.
Not everything is approved by all in
good faith.

17 Be ashamed of sexual immorality
before father and mother,
of a lie before a prince and a mighty
man,
18 of an offense before a judge and
ruler,
of iniquity before the congregation
and the people,
of unjust dealing before a partner
and friend,
19 and of theft in the place where you
sojourn.
Be ashamed in regard of the truth of God
and his covenant,
of leaning on your elbow at dinner,
of contemptuous behavior in the
matter of giving and taking,
20 of silence before those who greet
you,
of looking at a woman who is a
prostitute,
21 of turning away your face from a
kinsman,
of taking away a portion or a gift,
of gazing at a woman who has a
husband,
22 of meddling with his maid—and
don't come near her bed,
of abusive speech to friends—and
after you have given, don't insult,
23 of repeating and speaking what you
have heard,
and of revealing of secrets.
24 So you will be ashamed of the right
things
and find favor in the sight of every
man.

† **41:4** or, *the place of the dead* or, *Sheol* ‡ **41:8** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities.

42

1 Don't be ashamed of these things,
and don't sin to save face:
2 of the law of the Most High and his covenant,
of judgment to do justice to the ungodly,
3 of reckoning with a partner and with travellers,
of a gift from the inheritance of friends,
4 of exactness of scales and weights,
of getting much or little,
5 of bargaining dealing with merchants,
of frequent correction of children,
and of making the back of an evil slave to bleed.
6 A seal is good where an evil wife is.
Where there are many hands, lock things up.
7 Whatever you hand over, let it be by number and weight.
In giving and receiving, let all be in writing.
8 Don't be ashamed to instruct the unwise and foolish,
and one of extreme old age who contends with those who are young.
So you will be well instructed indeed
and approved in the sight of every living man.

9 A daughter is a secret cause of wakefulness to a father.
Care for her takes away sleep—
in her youth, lest she pass the flower of her age;
when she is married, lest she should be hated;
10 in her virginity, lest she should be defiled and be with child in her father's house;
when she has a husband, lest she should transgress;
and when she is married, lest she should be barren.
11 Keep a strict watch over a headstrong daughter,
lest she make you a laughingstock to your enemies,
a byword in the city and notorious among the people,
and shame you in public.

12 Don't gaze at every beautiful body.
Don't sit in the midst of women.
13 For from garments comes a moth,
and from a woman comes a woman's wickedness.
14 Better is the wickedness of a man than a pleasant woman,
a woman who puts you to shame and disgrace.

15 I will make mention now of the works of the Lord,
and will declare the things that I have seen.
The Lord's works are in his words.
16 The sun that gives light looks at all things.
The Lord's work is full of his glory.
17 The Lord has not given power to the saints to declare all his marvelous works,
which the Almighty Lord firmly settled,
that the universe might be established in his glory.
18 He searches out the deep and the heart.
He has understanding of their secrets.
For the Most High knows all knowledge.
He sees the signs of the world.
19 He declares the things that are past and the things that shall be,
and reveals the traces of hidden things.
20 No thought escapes him.
There is not a word hidden from him.
21 He has ordered the mighty works of his wisdom.
He is from everlasting to everlasting.
Nothing has been added to them, nor diminished from them.
He had no need of any counselor.
22 How desirable are all his works!
One may see this even in a spark.
23 All these things live and remain forever in all manner of uses.
They are all obedient.
24 All things are in pairs, one opposite the other.
He has made nothing imperfect.

25 One thing establishes the good things of another.
Who could ever see enough of his glory?

43

1 The pride of the heavenly heights is the clear sky,
the appearance of heaven, in the spectacle of its glory.
2 The sun, when it appears, bringing tidings as it rises,
is a marvelous instrument, the work of the Most High.
3 At noon, it dries up the land.
Who can stand against its burning heat?
4 A man tending a furnace is in burning heat,
but the sun three times more, burning up the mountains,
breathing out fiery vapors,
and sending out bright beams, it blinds the eyes.
5 Great is the Lord who made it.
At his word, he hastens on its course.

6 The moon marks the changing seasons,
declares times, and is a sign for the world.
7 From the moon is the sign of feast days,
a light that wanes when it completes its course.
8 The month is called after its name,
increasing wonderfully in its changing—
an instrument of the army on high,
shining in the structure of heaven,
9 the beauty of heaven, the glory of the stars,
an ornament giving light in the highest places of the Lord.
10 At the word of the Holy One, they will stand in due order.
They won't faint in their watches.
11 Look at the rainbow, and praise him who made it.
It is exceedingly beautiful in its brightness.
12 It encircles the sky with its glorious circle.
The hands of the Most High have stretched it out.

13 By his commandment, he makes the snow fall
and swiftly sends the lightnings of his judgment.
14 Therefore the storehouses are opened,
and clouds fly out like birds.
15 By his mighty power, he makes the clouds strong
and the hailstones are broken in pieces.
16 At his appearing, the mountains will be shaken.
At his will, the south wind will blow.
17 The voice of his thunder rebukes the earth.
So does the northern storm and the whirlwind.
Like birds flying down, he sprinkles the snow.
It falls down like the lighting of locusts.
18 The eye is dazzled at the beauty of its whiteness.
The heart is amazed as it falls.
19 He also pours out frost on the earth like salt.
When it is freezes, it has points like thorns.

20 The cold north wind blows
and ice freezes on the water.
It settles on every pool of water.
The water puts it on like it was a breastplate.
21 It will devour the mountains, burn up the wilderness,
and consume the green grass like fire.
22 A mist coming speedily heals all things.
A dew coming after heat brings cheerfulness.

23 By his counsel, he has calmed the deep
and planted islands in it.
24 Those who sail on the sea tell of its dangers.
We marvel when we hear it with our ears.
25 There are also those strange and wondrous works in it—
variety of all that has life and the huge creatures of the sea.

26 Because of him, his messengers succeed.
By his word, all things hold together.

27 We may say many things, but couldn't say enough.
The summary of our words is, "He is everything!"
28 How could we have strength to glorify him?
For he is himself the greater than all his works.
29 The Lord is awesome and exceedingly great!
His power is marvelous!
30 Glorify the Lord and exalt him as much as you can!
For even yet, he will surpass that.
When you exalt him, summon your full strength.
Don't be weary, because you can't praise him enough.
31 Who has seen him, that he may describe him?
Who can magnify him as he is?
32 Many things greater than these are hidden,
for we have seen just a few of his works.
33 For the Lord made all things.
He gave wisdom to the godly.

44

1 Let us now praise famous men,
our ancestors in their generations.
2 The Lord created great glory in them—
his mighty power from the beginning.
3 Some ruled in their kingdoms
and were men renowned for their power,
giving counsel by their understanding.
Some have spoken in prophecies,
4 leaders of the people by their counsels,
and by their understanding, giving instruction for the people.
Their words in their instruction were wise.
5 Some composed musical tunes,
and set forth verses in writing,
6 rich men endowed with ability,
living peaceably in their homes.
7 All these were honored in their generations,
and were outstanding in their days.
8 Some of them have left a name behind them,
so that others declare their praises.
9 But of others, there is no memory.
They perished as though they had not been.
They become as though they had not been born,
they and their children after them.
10 But these were men of mercy,
whose righteous deeds have not been forgotten.
11 A good inheritance remains with their offspring.
Their children are within the covenant.
12 Their offspring stand fast,
with their children, for their sakes.
13 Their offspring will remain forever.
Their glory won't be blotted out.
14 Their bodies were buried in peace.
Their name lives to all generations.
15 People will declare their wisdom.
The congregation proclaims their praise.

16 Enoch pleased the Lord, and was taken up,
an example of repentance to all generations.

17 Noah was found perfect and righteous.
In the season of wrath, he kept the race alive.
Therefore a remnant was left on the earth when the flood came.
18 Everlasting covenants were made with him,
that all flesh should no more be blotted out by a flood.

19 Abraham was a great father of a multitude of nations.
There was none found like him in glory,
20 who kept the law of the Most High,
and was taken into covenant with him.

In his flesh he established the covenant.
When he was tested, he was found faithful.
21 Therefore he assured him by an oath
that the nations would be blessed through his offspring,
that he would multiply him like the dust of the earth,
exalt his offspring like the stars,
and cause them to inherit from sea to sea,
and from the Euphrates River to the utmost parts of the earth.

22 In Isaac also, he established the same assurance for Abraham his father's sake,
the blessing of all men, and the covenant.
23 He made it rest upon the head of Jacob.
He acknowledged him in his blessings,
gave to him by inheritance,
and divided his portions.
He distributed them among twelve tribes.

45

1 He brought out of him a man of mercy,
who found favor in the sight of all people,
a man loved by God and men, even Moses,
whose memory is blessed.
2 He made him equal to the glory of the saints,
and magnified him in the fears of his enemies.
3 By his words he caused the wonders to cease.
God glorified him in the sight of kings.
He gave him commandments for his people
and showed him part of his glory.
4 He sanctified him in his faithfulness and meekness.
He chose him out of all people.
5 He made him to hear his voice,
led him into the thick darkness,
and gave him commandments face to face,
even the law of life and knowledge,
that he might teach Jacob the covenant,
and Israel his judgments.

6 He exalted Aaron, a holy man like Moses,
even his brother, of the tribe of Levi.
7 He established an everlasting covenant with him,
and gave him the priesthood of the people.
He blessed him with stateliness,
and dressed him in a glorious robe.
8 He clothed him in perfect splendor,
and strengthened him with symbols of authority:
the linen trousers, the long robe, and the ephod.
9 He encircled him with pomegranates;
with many golden bells around him,
to make a sound as he went,
to make a sound that might be heard in the temple,
for a reminder for the children of his people;
10 with a holy garment, with gold, blue, and purple, the work of the embroiderer;
with an oracle of judgment—Urim and Thummim;
11 with twisted scarlet, the work of the craftsman;
with precious stones engraved like a signet, in a setting of gold, the work of the jeweller,
for a reminder engraved in writing, after the number of the tribes of Israel;
12 with a crown of gold upon the mitre, having engraved on it, as on a signet, "HOLINESS",
an ornament of honor, the work of an expert,
the desires of the eyes, goodly and beautiful.
13 Before him there never have been anything like it.
No stranger put them on, but only his sons and his offspring perpetually.
14 His sacrifices shall be wholly burned, twice every day continually.
15 Moses consecrated him,
and anointed him with holy oil.
It was an everlasting covenant with him

and to his offspring, all the days of heaven,
to minister to the Lord, to serve as a priest,
and to bless his people in his name.
16 He chose him out of all living
to offer sacrifice to the Lord—
incense, and a sweet fragrance, for a memorial,
to make atonement for your people.
17 He gave to him in his commandments,
authority in the covenants of judgments,
to teach Jacob the testimonies,
and to enlighten Israel in his law.
18 Strangers conspired against him
and envied him in the wilderness:
Dathan and Abiram with their company,
and the congregation of Korah, with wrath and anger.
19 The Lord saw it, and it displeased him.
In the wrath of his anger, they were destroyed.
He did wonders upon them,
to consume them with flaming fire.
20 He added glory to Aaron,
and gave him a heritage.
He divided to him the first fruits of the increase,
and prepared bread of first fruits in abundance.
21 For they eat the sacrifices of the Lord,
which he gave to him and to his offspring.
22 However, in the land of the people, he has no inheritance,
and he has no portion among the people,
for the Lord himself is your portion and inheritance.

23 Phinehas the son of Eleazar is the third in glory,
in that he was zealous in the fear of the Lord,
and stood fast when the people turned away,
and he made atonement for Israel.
24 Therefore, a covenant of peace was established for him,
that he should be leader of the sanctuary and of his people,
that he and his offspring should have the dignity of the priesthood forever.
25 Also he made a covenant with David the son of Jesse, of the tribe of Judah.
The inheritance of the king is his alone from son to son.
So the inheritance of Aaron is also to his seed.

26 May God give you wisdom in your heart
to judge his people in righteousness,
that their good things may not be abolished,
and that their glory may endure for all their generations.

46

1 Joshua the son of Nun was valiant in war,
and was the successor of Moses in prophecies.
He was made great according to his name
for the saving of† God's elect,
to take vengeance on the enemies that rose up against them,
that he might give Israel their inheritance.
2 How he was glorified in the lifting up his hands,
and in stretching out his sword against the cities!
3 Who before him stood so firm?
For the Lord himself brought his enemies to him.
4 Didn't the sun go back by his hand?
Didn't one day become as two?
5 He called upon the Most High, the Mighty One,
when his foes pressed in all around him,
and the great Lord heard him.
6 With hailstones of mighty power,
he caused war to break violently upon the nation,
and‡ on the slope he destroyed those who resisted,
so that the nations might know his armor,
how he fought in the sight of the Lord;

† **46:1** Gr. *his.* ‡ **46:6** See Joshua 10:11

for he followed the Mighty One.
7 Also in the time of Moses, he did a work
of mercy—
he and Caleb the son of Jephunneh—
in that they withstood the adversary,
hindered the people from sin,
and stilled their wicked complaining.
8 And of six hundred thousand people on
foot, they two alone were preserved
to bring them into their inheritance,
into a land flowing with milk and
honey.
9 The Lord gave strength to Caleb,
and it remained with him to his old
age,
so that he entered the hill country,
and his offspring obtained it for an
inheritance,
10 that all the children of Israel might
see that it is good to follow the Lord.

11 Also the judges, every one by his name,
all whose hearts didn't engage in
immorality,
and who didn't turn away from the
Lord—
may their memory be blessed!
12 May their bones flourish again out of
their place.
May the name of those who have
been honored be renewed in their
children.

13 Samuel, the prophet of the Lord, loved
by his Lord,
established a kingdom and anointed
princes over his people.
14 By the law of the Lord he judged the
congregation,
and the Lord watched over Jacob.
15 By his faithfulness he was proved to be
a prophet.
By his words he was known to be
faithful in vision.
16 When his enemies pressed on him on
every side,
he called upon the Lord, the Mighty
One,
with the offering of the suckling lamb.
17 Then the Lord thundered from heaven.
He made his voice heard with a
mighty sound.
18 He utterly destroyed the rulers of the
Tyrians
and all the princes of the Philistines.
19 Before the time of his age-long sleep,
he testified in the sight of the lord and
his anointed,
"I have not taken any man's goods, so
much as a sandal;"
and no one accused him.
20 Even after he fell asleep, he prophesied,
and showed the king his end,
and lifted up his voice from the earth
in prophecy,
to blot out the wickedness of the
people.

47

1 After him, Nathan rose up
to prophesy in the days of David.
2 As is the fat when it is separated from the
peace offering,
so was David separated from the
children of Israel.
3 He played with lions as with kids,
and with bears as with lambs of the
flock.
4 In his youth didn't he kill a giant,
and take away reproach from the
people
when he lifted up his hand with a
sling stone,
and beat down the boasting Goliath?
5 For he called upon the Most High Lord,
and he gave him strength in his right
hand
to kill a man mighty in war,
to exalt the horn of his people.
6 So they glorified him for his tens of
thousands,
and praised him for the blessings of
the Lord,
in that a glorious diadem was given to
him.
7 For he destroyed the enemies on every
side,
and defeated the Philistines his
adversaries.
He broke their horn in pieces to this
day.
8 In every work of his he gave thanks to
the Holy One Most High with words
of glory.

He sang praise with his whole heart,
and loved him who made him.
9 He set singers before the altar,
to make sweet melody by their music.†
10 He gave beauty to the feasts,
and set in order the seasons to completion
while they praised his holy name,
and the sanctuary resounded from early morning.
11 The Lord took away his sins,
and exalted his horn forever.
He gave him a covenant of kings,
and a glorious throne in Israel.

12 After him a wise son rose up,
who because of him lived in security.
13 Solomon reigned in days of peace.
God gave him rest all around,
that he might set up a house for his name,
and prepare a sanctuary forever.
14 How wise you were made in your youth,
and filled as a river with understanding!
15 Your influence covered the earth,
and you filled it with parables and riddles.
16 Your name reached to the far away islands,
and you were loved for your peace.
17 For your songs, proverbs, parables,
and interpretations, the countries marveled at you.
18 By the name of the Lord God,
who is called the God of Israel,
you gathered gold like tin,
and multiplied silver like lead.
19 You bowed your loins to women,
and in your body you were brought into subjection.
20 You blemished your honor,
and defiled your offspring,
to bring wrath upon your children.
I was grieved for your folly,
21 because the sovereignty was divided,
and a disobedient kingdom ruled out of Ephraim.
22 But the Lord will never forsake his mercy.
He won't destroy any of his works,
nor blot out the posterity of his elect.
He won't take away the offspring of him who loved him.
He gave a remnant to Jacob,
and to David a root from his own family.

23 So Solomon rested with his fathers.
Of his offspring, he left behind him Rehoboam,
the foolishness of the people, and one who lacked understanding,
who made the people revolt by his counsel.
Also Jeroboam the son of Nebat,
who made Israel to sin,
and gave a way of sin to Ephraim.
24 Their sins were multiplied exceedingly,
until they were removed from their land.
25 For they sought out all manner of wickedness,
until vengeance came upon them.

48

1 Then Elijah arose, the prophet like fire.
His word burned like a torch.
2 He brought a famine upon them,
and by his zeal made them few in number.
3 By the word of the Lord he shut up the heavens.
He brought down fire three times.
4 How you were glorified, O Elijah, in your wondrous deeds!
Whose glory is like yours?
5 You raised up a dead man from death,
from Hades, by the word of the Most High.
6 You brought down kings to destruction,
and honorable men from their sickbeds.
7 You heard rebuke in Sinai,
and judgments of vengeance in Horeb.
8 You anointed kings for retribution,
and prophets to succeed after you.
9 You were taken up in a tempest of fire,

† **47:9** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities.

in a chariot of fiery horses.
10 You were recorded for reproofs in their seasons,
to pacify anger, before it broke out into wrath,
to turn the heart of the father to the son,
and to restore the tribes of Jacob.
11 Blessed are those who saw you,
and those who have been beautified with love;
for we also shall surely live.

12 Elijah was wrapped in a whirlwind.
Elisha was filled with his spirit.
In his days he was not moved by the fear of any ruler,
and no one brought him into subjection.
13 Nothing was too hard for him.
When he was buried, his body prophesied.
14 As in his life he did wonders,
so his works were also marvelous in death.
15 For all this the people didn't repent.
They didn't depart from their sins,
until they were carried away as a plunder from their land,
and were scattered through all the earth.
The people were left very few in number,
but with a ruler from the house of David.
16 Some of them did that which was right,
but some multiplied sins.

17 Hezekiah fortified his city,
and brought water into its midst.
He tunneled through rock with iron,
and built cisterns for water.
18 In his days Sennacherib invaded,
and sent Rabshakeh, and departed.
He lifted up his hand against Zion,
and boasted great things in his arrogance.
19 Then their hearts and their hands were shaken,
and they were in pain, as women in labor.
20 But they called upon the Lord who is merciful,
spreading out their hands to him.
The Holy One quickly heard them out of Heaven,
and delivered them by the hand of Isaiah.
21 He struck the camp of the Assyrians,
and his angel utterly destroyed them.
22 For Hezekiah did that which was pleasing to the Lord,
and was strong in the ways of his ancestor David,
which Isaiah the prophet commanded,
who was great and faithful in his vision.

23 In his days the sun went backward.
He prolonged the life of the king.
24 He saw by an excellent spirit what would come to pass in the future;
and he comforted those who mourned in Zion.
25 He showed the things that would happen through the end of time,
and the hidden things before they came.

49

1 The memory of Josiah is like the composition of incense
prepared by the work of the perfumer.
It will be sweet as honey in every mouth,
and like music at a banquet of wine.
2 He did what was right in the reforming of the people,
and took away the abominations of iniquity.
3 He set his heart right toward the Lord.
In lawless days, he made godliness prevail.

4 Except David, Hezekiah, and Josiah,
all were wicked,
because they abandoned the law of the Most High.
The kings of Judah came to an end.
5 They gave their power to others,
and their glory to a foreign nation.
6 They set the chosen city of the sanctuary on fire

and made her streets desolate, as it
was written by the hand of
Jeremiah.
7 For they mistreated him;
yet he was sanctified in the womb to
be a prophet,
to root out, to afflict, to destroy
and likewise to build and to plant.

8 Ezekiel saw the vision of glory,
which God showed him on the chariot
of the cherubim.
9 For truly he remembered the enemies in
rainstorm,
and to do good to those who directed
their ways aright.
10 Also of the twelve prophets,†
may their bones flourish again out of
their place.
He comforted the people of Jacob,
and delivered them by confident
hope.

11 How shall we magnify Zerubbabel?
He was like a signet ring on the right
hand.
12 So was Jesus the son of Josedek,
who in their days built the house,
and exalted a‡ people holy to the Lord,
prepared for everlasting glory.
13 Also of Nehemiah the memory is great.
He raised up for us fallen walls,
set up the gates and bars,
and rebuilt our houses.

14 No man was created upon the earth like
Enoch,
for he was taken up from the earth.
15 Nor was there a man born like Joseph,
a leader of his kindred, a supporter of
the people.
Even his bones were cared for.
16 Shem and Seth were honored among
men,
but above every living thing in the
creation was Adam.

50

1 It was Simon, the son of Onias, the high
priest,
who in his life repaired the house,
and in his days strengthened the
temple.
2 The foundation was built by him to the
height of the double walls,
the lofty retaining walls of the temple
enclosure.
3 In his days, a water cistern was dug,
the brazen vessel like the sea in
circumference.
4 He planned to save his people from ruin,
and fortified the city against siege.
5 How glorious he was when the people
gathered around him
as he came out of the house of the
veil!
6 He was like the morning star among
clouds,
like the full moon,
7 like the sun shining on the temple of
the Most High,
like the rainbow shining in clouds of
glory,
8 like roses in the days of first fruits,
like lilies by a water spring,
like the shoot of the frankincense tree
in summer time,
9 like fire and incense in the censer,
like a vessel of beaten gold adorned
with all kinds of precious stones,
10 like an olive tree loaded with fruit,
and like a cypress growing high
among the clouds.
11 When he put on his glorious robe,
and clothed himself in perfect
splendor,
ascending to the holy altar,
he made the court of the sanctuary
glorious.

12 When he received the portions out of
the priests' hands,
as he stood by the hearth of the altar,
with his kindred like a garland
around him,
he was like a young cedar in Lebanon
surrounded by the trunks of palm
trees.
13 All the sons of Aaron in their glory,

† **49:10** The remainder of this line is omitted by the best authorities. ‡ **49:12** Some ancient authorities read *temple.*

held the Lord's offering in their hands
before all the congregation of
Israel.
14 Finishing the service at the altars,
that he might arrange the offering of
the Most High, the Almighty,
15 he stretched out his hand to the cup
of libation,
and poured out the cup of the grape.
He poured it out at the foot of the altar,
a sweet smelling fragrance to the
Most High, the King of all.
16 Then the sons of Aaron shouted.
They sounded the trumpets of beaten
work.
They made a great fanfare to be heard,
for a reminder before the Most High.
17 Then all the people together hurried,
and fell down to the ground on their
faces
to worship their Lord, the Almighty,
God Most High.

18 The singers also praised him with their
voices.
There was a sweet melody in the
whole house.
19 And the people implored the Lord Most
High,
in prayer before him who is merciful,
until the worship of the Lord was
finished,
and so they accomplished his service.
20 Then he went down, and lifted up his
hands
over the whole congregation of the
children of Israel,
to give blessing to the Lord with his
lips,
and to glory in his name.
21 He bowed himself down in worship the
second time,
to declare the blessing from the Most
High.

22 Now bless the God of all,
who everywhere does great things,
who exalts our days from the womb,
and deals with us according to his
mercy.
23 May he grant us joyfulness of heart,
and that peace may be in our days in
Israel for the days of eternity,
24 to entrust his mercy with us,
and let him deliver us in his time!

25 With two nations my soul is vexed,
and the third is no nation:
26 Those who sit on the mountain of†
Samaria, the Philistines,
and the foolish people who live in
Shechem.

27 I have written in this book the
instruction of understanding and
knowledge,
I Jesus, the son of Sirach Eleazar, of
Jerusalem,
who out of his heart poured forth
wisdom.
28 Blessed is he who will exercise these
things.
He who lays them up in his heart will
become wise.
29 For if he does them, he will be strong in
all things,
for the light of the Lord is his guide.‡

51

A Prayer of Jesus the son of Sirach.

1 I will give thanks to you, O Lord, O King,
and will praise you, O God my Savior.
I give thanks to your name,
2 for you have been my protector and
helper,
and delivered my body out of
destruction,
and out of the snare of a slanderous
tongue,
from lips that fabricate lies.
You were my helper before those who
stood by,
3 and delivered me, according to the
abundance of your mercy and of
your name,
from the gnashings of teeth ready to
devour,
out of the hand of those seeking my
life,
out of the many afflictions I endured,

† **50:26** According to some ancient versions, *Seir.*

‡ **50:29** The remainder of this verse is omitted by the best authorities.

4 from the choking of a fire on every
side,
and out of the midst of fire that I
hadn't kindled,
5 out of the depth of the belly of Hades,
from an unclean tongue,
and from lying words—
6 the slander of an unrighteous
tongue to the king.
My soul drew near to death.
My life was near to Hades.
7 They surrounded me on every side.
There was no one to help me.
I was looking for human help,
and there was none.
8 Then I remembered your mercy, O Lord,
and your working which has been
from everlasting,
how you deliver those who wait for
you,
and save them out of the hand of their
enemies.
9 I lifted up my prayer from the earth,
and prayed for deliverance from
death.
10 I called upon the Lord, the Father of my
Lord,
that he would not forsake me in the
days of affliction,
in the time when there was no help
against the proud.
11 I will praise your name continually.
I will sing praise with thanksgiving.
My prayer was heard.
12 You saved me from destruction
and delivered me from the evil time.
Therefore I will give thanks and praise to
you,
and bless the name of the Lord.

13 When I was yet young,
before I went abroad,
I sought wisdom openly in my prayer.
14 Before the temple I asked for her.
I will seek her out even to the end.
15 From the first flower to the ripening
grape my heart delighted in her.
My foot walked in uprightness.
From my youth I followed her steps.
16 I inclined my ear a little, and received
her,
and found for myself much
instruction.
17 I profited in her.
I will give glory to him who gives me
wisdom.
18 For I determined to practice her.
I was zealous for that which is good.
I will never be put to shame.
19 My soul has wrestled with her.
In my conduct I was exact.
I spread out my hands to the sky above,
and bewailed my ignorances of her.
20 I directed my soul to her.
In purity I found her.
I got myself a heart joined with her from
the beginning.
Therefore I won't be forsaken.
21 My belly also was troubled to seek her.
Therefore I have gained a good
possession.
22 The Lord gave me a tongue for my
reward.
I will praise him with it.

23 Draw near to me, all you who are
uneducated,
and live in the house of instruction.
24 Why therefore are you all lacking in
these things,
and your souls are very thirsty?
25 I opened my mouth and spoke,
"Get her for yourselves without
money."
26 Put your neck under the yoke,
and let your soul receive instruction.
She is near to find.

27 See with your eyes
how I labored just a little
and found for myself much rest.
28 Get instruction with a great sum of
silver,
and gain much gold by her.
29 May your soul rejoice in his mercy,
and may you all not be put to shame
in praising him.
30 Work your work before the time comes,
and in his time he will give you your
reward.

Baruch

The book of *Baruch* is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches. In some Bibles, Baruch chapter 6 is listed as a separate book called *The Letter of Jeremiah*, reflecting its separation from Baruch in some copies of the Greek Septuagint.

1 These are the words of the book which Baruch the son of Nerias, the son of Maaseas, the son of Sedekias, the son of Asadias, the son of Helkias, wrote in Babylon,
2 in the fifth year, in the seventh day of the month, at the time when the Chaldeans took Jerusalem and burned it with fire.
3 Baruch read the words of this book in the hearing of Jechonias the son of Joakim king of Judah, and in the hearing of all the people who came to hear the book,
4 and in the hearing of the mighty men, and of the kings' sons, and in the hearing of the elders, and in the hearing of all the people, from the least to the greatest, even of all those who lived at Babylon by the river Sud.
5 Then they wept, fasted,† and prayed before the Lord.
6 They also made a collection of money according to every man's ability;
7 and they sent it to Jerusalem to Joakim the high priest, the son of Helkias, the son of Salom, and to the priests and to all the people who were found with him at Jerusalem,
8 at the same time when he took the vessels of the house of the Lord, that had been carried out of the temple, to return them into the land of Judah, the tenth day of Sivan—silver vessels which Sedekias the son of Josias king of Judah had made,
9 after Nabuchodonosor king of Babylon had carried away Jechonias, the princes, the captives, the mighty men, and the people of the land from Jerusalem, and brought them to Babylon.
10 And they said: Behold, we have sent you money; therefore buy with the money burnt offerings, sin offerings, and incense, and prepare an oblation, and offer upon the altar of the Lord our God;
11 and pray for the life of Nabuchodonosor king of Babylon, and for the life of Baltasar his son, that their days may be‡ as the days of heaven above the earth.
12 The Lord will give us strength and light to our eyes. We will live under the shadow of Nabuchodonosor king of Babylon and under the shadow of Baltasar his son, and we shall serve them many days, and find favor in their sight.
13 Pray for us also to the Lord our God, for we have sinned against the Lord our God. To this day the wrath of the Lord and his indignation is not turned from us.
14 You shall read this book which we have sent to you, to make confession in the house of the Lord upon the day of the feast and on the days of the solemn assembly.
15 You shall say: To the Lord our God belongs righteousness, but to us confusion of face, as at this day—to the men of Judah, to the inhabitants of Jerusalem,
16 to our kings, to our princes, to our priests, to our prophets, and to our fathers,
17 because we have sinned before the Lord.
18 We have disobeyed him and have not listened to the voice of the Lord our God, to walk in the commandments of the Lord that he has set before us.
19 Since the day that the Lord brought our fathers out of the land of Egypt to this present day, we have been disobedient to the Lord our God, and we have been negligent in not listening to his voice.
20 Therefore the plagues have clung to us, along with the curse which the Lord declared through Moses his servant in the day that he brought our fathers out of the land of Egypt to give us a land that flows with milk and honey, as at this day.
21 Nevertheless we didn't listen to the

† **1:5** Another reading is, *and vowed vows.* ‡ **1:11** See Deuteronomy 11:21.

voice of the Lord our God, according to all the words of the prophets whom he sent to us,
22 but we each walked in the imagination of his own wicked heart, to serve strange gods and to do what is evil in the sight of the Lord our God.

2

1 Therefore the Lord has made good his word which he pronounced against us, and against our judges who judged Israel, and against our kings, and against our princes, and against the men of Israel and Judah,
2 to bring upon us great plagues such as never happened before under the whole heaven,† as it came to pass in Jerusalem, according to the things that are written in the law of Moses,
3 that we should each eat the flesh of our own son, and each eat the flesh of our own daughter.
4 Moreover he has given them to be in subjection to all the kingdoms that are around us, to be a reproach and a desolation among all the people around us, where the Lord has scattered them.
5 Thus they were cast down and not exalted, because we sinned against the Lord our God in not listening to his voice.
6 To the Lord our God belongs righteousness, but to us and to our fathers confusion of face, as at this day.
7 All these plagues have come upon us which the Lord has pronounced against us.
8 Yet have we not entreated the favor of the Lord by everyone turning from the thoughts of his wicked heart.
9 Therefore the Lord has kept watch over the plagues. The Lord has brought them upon us, for the Lord is righteous in all his works which he has commanded us.
10 Yet we have not listened to his voice, to walk in the commandments of the Lord that he has set before us.
11 And now, O Lord, you God of Israel who have brought your people out of the land of Egypt with a mighty hand, with signs, with wonders, with great power, and with a high arm, and have gotten yourself a name, as at this day:
12 O Lord our God, we have sinned. We have been ungodly. We have done wrong in all your ordinances.
13 Let your wrath turn from us, for we are but a few left among the heathen where you have scattered us.
14 Hear our prayer, O Lord, and our petition, and deliver us for your own sake. Give us favor in the sight of those who have led us away captive,
15 that all the earth may know that you are the Lord our God, because Israel and his posterity is called by your name.
16 O Lord, look down from your holy house and consider us. Incline your ear, O Lord, and hear.
17 Open your eyes, and see; for the dead that are in Hades, whose breath is taken from their bodies, will give to the Lord neither glory nor righteousness;
18 but the soul who is greatly vexed, who goes stooping and feeble, and the eyes that fail, and the hungry soul, will declare your glory and righteousness, O Lord.
19 For we do not present our supplication before you, O Lord our God, for the righteousness of our fathers and of our kings.
20 For you have sent your wrath and your indignation upon us, as you have spoken by your servants the prophets, saying,
21 "The Lord says, 'Bow your shoulders to serve the king of Babylon, and remain in the land that I gave to your fathers.
22 But if you won't hear the voice of the Lord to serve the king of Babylon,
23 I will cause to cease out of the cities of Judah and from the region near Jerusalem the voice of mirth, the voice of gladness, voice of the bridegroom, and the voice of the bride. The whole land will be desolate without inhabitant.' "
24 But we wouldn't listen to your voice, to serve the king of Babylon. Therefore you have made good your words that you spoke by your servants the prophets, that

† **2:2** Another reading is, *even as he has done.*

the bones of our kings and the bones of our fathers would be taken out of their places.
25 Behold, they are cast out to the heat by day and to the frost by night. They died in great miseries by famine, by sword, and by‡ pestilence.
26 You have made the house that is called by your name as it is today because of the wickedness of the house of Israel and the house of Judah.
27 Yet, O Lord our God, you have dealt with us after all your kindness and according to all your great mercy,
28 as you spoke by your servant Moses in the day when you commanded him to write your law in the presence of the children of Israel, saying,
29 "If you won't hear my voice, surely this very great multitude will be turned into a small number among the nations where I will scatter them.
30 For I know that they will not hear me, because they are a stiff-necked people; but in the land of their captivity they will take it to heart,
31 and will know that I am the Lord their God. I will give them a heart and ears to hear.
32 Then they will praise me in the land of their captivity, and think about my name,
33 and will return from their stiff neck and from their wicked deeds; for they will remember the way of their fathers who sinned before the Lord.
34 I will bring them again into the land which I promised to their fathers, to Abraham, to Isaac, and to Jacob, and they will rule over it. I will increase them, and they won't be diminished.
35 And I will make an everlasting covenant with them to be their God, and they will be my people. I will no more remove my people Israel out of the land that I have given them."

3

1 O Lord Almighty, you God of Israel, the soul in anguish and the troubled spirit cries to you.
2 Hear, O Lord, and have mercy; for you are a merciful God. Yes, have mercy upon us, because we have sinned before you.
3 For you are enthroned forever, and we keep perishing.
4 O Lord Almighty, you God of Israel, hear now the prayer of the dead Israelites, and of the children of those who were sinners before you, who didn't listen to the voice of you their God; because of this, these plagues cling to us.
5 Don't remember the iniquities of our fathers, but remember your power and your name at this time.
6 For you are the Lord our God, and we will praise you, O Lord.
7 For this cause, you have put your fear in our hearts, to the intent that we should call upon your name. We will praise you in our captivity, for we have called to mind all the iniquity of our fathers who sinned before you.
8 Behold, we are yet this day in our captivity where you have scattered us, for a reproach and a curse, and to be subject to penalty according to all the iniquities of our fathers who departed from the Lord our God.
9 Hear, O Israel, the commandments of life! Give ear to understand wisdom!
10 How is it, O Israel, that you are in your enemies' land, that you have become old in a strange country, that you are defiled with the dead,
11 that you are counted with those who are in Hades?
12 You have forsaken the fountain of wisdom.
13 If you had walked in the way of God, you would have dwelled in peace forever.
14 Learn where there is wisdom, where there is strength, and where there is understanding, that you may also know where there is length of days and life, where there is the light of the eyes and peace.
15 Who has found out her place? Who has come into her treasuries?
16 Where are the princes of the heathen, and those who ruled the beasts that are on the earth,

‡ **2:25** See Jeremiah 32:36.

17 those who had their pastime with the
fowls of the air, and those who hoarded
up silver and gold, in which people trust,
and of their getting there is no end?
18 For those who diligently sought silver,
and were so anxious, and whose works
are past finding out,
19 they have vanished and gone down to
Hades, and others have come up in their
place.
20 Younger men have seen the light and
lived upon the earth, but they haven't
known the way of knowledge,
21 nor understood its paths. Their
children haven't embraced it. They are
far off from their way.
22 It has not been heard of in Canaan,
neither has it been seen in Teman.
23 The sons also of Agar who seek
understanding, which are in the land, the
merchants of Merran and Teman, and the
authors of fables, and the searchers out of
understanding—none of these have
known the way of wisdom or
remembered her paths.
24 O Israel, how great is the house of
God! How large is the place of his
possession!
25 It is great and has no end. It is high
and unmeasurable.
26 Giants were born that were famous of
old, great of stature, and expert in war.
27 God didn't choose these, nor did he
give the way of knowledge to them,
28 so they perished, because they had no
wisdom. They perished through their
own foolishness.
29 Who has gone up into heaven, taken
her, and brought her down from the
clouds?
30 Who has gone over the sea, found her,
and will bring her for choice gold?
31 There is no one who knows her way,
nor any who comprehend her path.
32 But he that knows all things knows
her, he found her out with his
understanding. He who prepared the
earth for all time has filled it with
four-footed beasts.
33 It is he who sends forth the light, and
it goes. He called it, and it obeyed him
with fear.
34 The stars shone in their watches, and
were glad. When he called them, they
said, "Here we are." They shone with
gladness to him who made them.
35 This is our God. No other can be
compared to him.
36 He has found out all the way of
knowledge, and has given it to Jacob his
servant and to Israel who is loved by him.
37 Afterward she appeared upon earth,
and lived with men.

4

1 This is the book of God's
commandments and the law that endures
forever. All those who hold it fast will live,
but those who leave it will die.
2 Turn, O Jacob, and take hold of it. Walk
toward the shining of its light.
3 Don't give your glory to another, nor
the things that are to your advantage to a
foreign nation.
4 O Israel, we are happy; for the things
that are pleasing to God are made known
to us.
5 Be of good cheer, my people, the
memorial of Israel.
6 You were not sold to the nations for
destruction, but because you moved God
to wrath, you were delivered to your
adversaries.
7 For you provoked him who made you
by sacrificing to demons and not to God.
8 You forgot the everlasting God who
brought you up. You also grieved
Jerusalem, who nursed you.
9 For she saw the wrath that came upon
you from God, and said, "Listen, you who
dwell near Zion; for God has brought
upon me great mourning.
10 For I have seen the captivity of my
sons and daughters, which the
Everlasting has brought upon them.
11 For with joy I nourished them, but
sent them away with weeping and
mourning.
12 Let no man rejoice over me, a widow
and forsaken by many. For the sins of my
children, I am left desolate, because they
turned away from the law of God
13 and had no regard for his statutes.
They didn't walk in the ways of God's

commandments or tread in the paths of discipline in his righteousness.
14 Let those who dwell near Zion come and remember the captivity of my sons and daughters, which the Everlasting has brought upon them.
15 For he has brought a nation upon them from afar, a shameless nation with a strange language, who didn't respect old men or pity children.
16 They have carried away the dear beloved sons of the widow, and left her who was alone desolate of her daughters."

17 But I—how can I help you?
18 For he who brought these calamities upon you will deliver you from the hand of your enemies.
19 Go your way, O my children. Go your way, for I am left desolate.
20 I have put off the garment of peace, and put on the sackcloth of my petition. I will cry to the Everlasting as long as I live.

21 Take courage, my children. Cry to God, and he will deliver you from the power and hand of the enemies.
22 For I have trusted in the Everlasting, that he will save you; and joy has come to me from the Holy One, because of the mercy that will soon come to you from your Everlasting Savior.
23 For I sent you out with mourning and weeping, but God will give you to me again with joy and gladness forever.
24 For as now those who dwell near Zion have seen your captivity, so they will shortly see your salvation from our God which will come upon you with great glory and brightness of the Everlasting.
25 My children, suffer patiently the wrath that has come upon you from God, for your enemy has persecuted you; but shortly you will see his destruction and will tread upon their necks.
26 My delicate ones have traveled rough roads. They were taken away like a flock carried off by enemies.

27 Take courage, my children, and cry to God; for you will be remembered by him who has brought this upon you.
28 For as it was your decision to go astray from God, return and seek him ten times more.
29 For he who brought these calamities upon you will bring you everlasting joy again with your salvation.
30 Take courage, O Jerusalem, for he who called you by name will comfort you.
31 Miserable are those who afflicted you and rejoiced at your fall.
32 Miserable are the cities which your children served. Miserable is she who received your sons.
33 For as she rejoiced at your fall and was glad of your ruin, so she will be grieved at her own desolation.
34 And I will take away her pride in her great multitude and her boasting will be turned into mourning.
35 For fire will come upon her from the Everlasting for many days; and she will be inhabited by demons for a long time.
36 O Jerusalem, look around you toward the east, and behold the joy that comes to you from God.
37 Behold, your sons come, whom you sent away. They come gathered together from the east to the west at the word of the Holy One, rejoicing in the glory of God.

5

1 Take off the garment of your mourning and affliction, O Jerusalem, and put on forever the beauty of the glory from God.
2 Put on the robe of the righteousness from God. Set on your head a diadem of the glory of the Everlasting.
3 For God will show your splendor everywhere under heaven.
4 For your name will be called by God forever "Righteous Peace, Godly Glory".
5 Arise, O Jerusalem, and stand upon the height. Look around you toward the east and see your children gathered from the going down of the sun to its rising at the word of the Holy One, rejoicing that God has remembered them.
6 For they went from you on foot, being led away by their enemies, but God brings them in to you carried on high with glory, on a royal throne.

7 For God has appointed that every high
mountain and the everlasting hills should
be made low, and the valleys filled up to
make the ground level, that Israel may go
safely in the glory of God.
8 Moreover the woods and every sweet
smelling tree have shaded Israel by the
commandment of God.
9 For God will lead Israel with joy in the
light of his glory with the mercy and
righteousness that come from him.

6

The Letter of Jeremy (Jeremiah)

1 A copy of a letter that Jeremy sent to
those who were to be led captives into
Babylon by the king of the Babylonians, to
give them the message that God
commanded him.
2 Because of the sins which you have
committed before God, you will be led
away captives to Babylon by
Nabuchodonosor king of the Babylonians.
3 So when you come to Babylon, you will
remain there many years, and for a long
season, even for seven generations. After
that, I will bring you out peacefully from
there.
4 But now you will see in Babylon gods
of silver, gold, and wood carried on
shoulders, which cause the nations to
fear.
5 Beware therefore that you in no way
become like these foreigners. Don't let
fear take hold of you because of them
when you see the multitude before them
and behind them, worshiping them.
6 But say in your hearts, "O Lord, we
must worship you."
7 For my angel is with you, and I myself
care for your souls.
8 For their tongue is polished by the
workman, and they themselves are
overlaid with gold and with silver; yet
they are only fake, and can't speak.
9 And taking gold, as if it were for a
virgin who loves to be happy, they make
crowns for the heads of their gods.
10 Sometimes also the priests take gold
and silver from their gods, and spend it on
themselves.
11 They will even give some of it to the
common prostitutes. They dress them like
men with garments, even the gods of
silver, gods of gold, and gods of wood.
12 Yet these gods can't save themselves
from rust and moths, even though they
are covered with purple garments.
13 They wipe their faces because of the
dust of the temple, which is thick upon
them.
14 And he who can't put to death one
who offends against him holds a sceptre,
as though he were judge of a country.
15 He has also a dagger in his right hand,
and an axe, but can't deliver himself from
war and robbers.
16 By this they are known not to be gods.
Therefore don't fear them.
17 For like a vessel that a man uses is
worth nothing when it is broken, even so
it is with their gods. When they are set up
in the temples, their eyes are full of dust
through the feet of those who come in.
18 As the courts are secured on every
side upon him who offends the king, as
being committed to suffer death, even so
the priests secure their temples with
doors, with locks, and bars, lest they be
carried off by robbers.
19 They light candles for them, yes, more
than for themselves, even though they
can't see one.
20 They are like one of the beams of the
temple. Men say their hearts are eaten out
when things creeping out of the earth
devour both them and their clothing.
They don't feel it
21 when their faces are blackened
through the smoke that comes out of the
temple.
22 Bats, swallows, and birds land on
their bodies and heads. So do the cats.
23 By this you may know that they are
no gods. Therefore don't fear them.
24 Notwithstanding the gold with which
they are covered to make them beautiful,
unless someone wipes off the tarnish,
they won't shine; for they didn't even feel
it when they were molten.
25 Things in which there is no breath are
bought at any cost.

26 Having no feet, they are carried upon
shoulders. By this, they declare to men
that they are worth nothing.
27 Those who serve them are also
ashamed, for if they fall to the ground at
any time, they can't rise up again by
themselves. If they are bowed down, they
can't make themselves straight; but the
offerings are set before them, as if they
were dead men.
28 And the things that are sacrificed to
them, their priests sell and spend. In like
manner, their wives also lay up part of it
in salt; but to the poor and to the impotent
they give none of it.
29 The menstruous woman and the
woman in childbed touch their sacrifices,
knowing therefore by these things that
they are no gods. Don't fear them.
30 For how can they be called gods?
Because women set food before the gods
of silver, gold, and wood.
31 And in their temples the priests sit on
seats, having their clothes torn and their
heads and beards shaven, and nothing on
their heads.
32 They roar and cry before their gods,
as men do at the feast when one is dead.
33 The priests also take off garments
from them and clothe their wives and
children with them.
34 Whether it is evil or good what one
does to them, they are not able to repay it.
They can't set up a king or put him down.
35 In like manner, they can neither give
riches nor money. Though a man make a
vow to them and doesn't keep it, they will
never exact it.
36 They can save no man from death.
They can't deliver the weak from the
mighty.
37 They can't restore a blind man to his
sight, or deliver anyone who is in distress.
38 They can show no mercy to the
widow, or do good to the fatherless.
39 They are like the stones that are cut
out of the mountain, these gods of wood
that are overlaid with gold and with
silver. Those who minister to them will be
confounded.
40 How could a man then think or say
that they are gods, when even the
Chaldeans themselves dishonor them?
41 If they shall see one mute who can't
speak, they bring him and ask him to call
upon Bel, as though he were able to
understand.
42 Yet they can't perceive this
themselves, and forsake them; for they
have no understanding.
43 The women also with cords around
them sit in the ways, burning bran for
incense; but if any of them, drawn by
someone who passes by, lies with him, she
reproaches her fellow, that she was not
thought as worthy as herself and her cord
wasn't broken.
44 Whatever is done among them is
false. How could a man then think or say
that they are gods?
45 They are fashioned by carpenters and
goldsmiths. They can be nothing else than
what the workmen make them to be.
46 And they themselves who fashioned
them can never continue long. How then
should the things that are fashioned by
them?
47 For they have left lies and reproaches
to those who come after.
48 For when there comes any war or
plague upon them, the priests consult
with themselves, where they may be
hidden with them.
49 How then can't men understand that
they are no gods, which can't save
themselves from war or from plague?
50 For seeing they are only wood and
overlaid with gold and silver, it will be
known hereafter that they are false.
51 It will be manifest to all nations and
kings that they are no gods, but the works
of men's hands, and that there is no work
of God in them.
52 Who then may not know that they are
not gods?

53 For they can't set up a king in a land
or give rain to men.
54 They can't judge their own cause, or
redress a wrong, being unable; for they
are like crows between heaven and earth.
55 For even when fire falls upon the
house of gods of wood overlaid with gold
or with silver, their priests will flee away,

and escape, but they themselves will be burned apart like beams.
56 Moreover they can't withstand any king or enemies. How could a man then admit or think that they are gods?
57 Those gods of wood overlaid with silver or with gold aren't able to escape from thieves or robbers.
58 The gold, silver, and garments with which they are clothed—those who are strong will take from them, and go away with them. They won't be able to help themselves.
59 Therefore it is better to be a king who shows his manhood, or else a vessel in a house profitable for whatever the owner needs, than such false gods—or even a door in a house, to keep the things safe that are in it, than such false gods; or better to be a pillar of wood in a palace than such false gods.
60 For sun, moon, and stars, being bright and sent to do their jobs, are obedient.
61 Likewise also the lightning when it flashes is beautiful to see. In the same way, the wind also blows in every country.
62 And when God commands the clouds to go over the whole world, they do as they are told.
63 And the fire sent from above to consume mountains and woods does as it is commanded; but these are to be compared to them neither in show nor power.
64 Therefore a man shouldn't think or say that they are gods, seeing they aren't able to judge causes or to do good to men.
65 Knowing therefore that they are no gods, don't fear them.
66 For they can neither curse nor bless kings.
67 They can't show signs in the heavens among the nations, or shine as the sun, or give light as the moon.
68 The beasts are better than they; for they can get under a covert, and help themselves.
69 In no way then is it manifest to us that they are gods. Therefore don't fear them.
70 For as a scarecrow in a garden of cucumbers that keeps nothing, so are their gods of wood overlaid with gold and silver.
71 Likewise also their gods of wood overlaid with gold and with silver are like a white thorn in an orchard that every bird sits upon. They are also like a dead body that is thrown out into the dark.
72 You will know them to be no gods by the bright purple that rots upon them. They themselves will be consumed afterwards, and will be a reproach in the country.
73 Better therefore is the just man who has no idols; for he will be far from reproach.

The First Book of the Maccabees

The First Book of the Maccabees is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches.

1 After Alexander the Macedonian, the
son of Philip, who came out of the land of
Chittim, and struck Darius king of the
Persians and Medes, it came to pass, after
he had struck him, that he reigned in his
place, in former time, over† Greece.
2 He fought many battles, won many
strongholds, killed the kings of the earth,
3 went through to the ends of the earth,
and took spoils of a multitude of nations.
The earth was quiet before him. He was
exalted. His heart was lifted up.
4 He gathered together an exceedingly
strong army and ruled over countries,
nations, and principalities, and they paid
him tribute.
5 After these things he fell sick, and
perceived that he was going to die.
6 He called his honorable servants,
which had been brought up with him
from his youth, and he divided to them his
kingdom while he was still alive.
7 Alexander reigned twelve years, then
he died.
8 Then his servants ruled, each one in
his place.
9 They all put crowns upon themselves
after he was dead, and so did their sons
after them many years; and they
multiplied evils in the earth.
10 There came out of them a sinful root,
Antiochus Epiphanes, son of Antiochus
the king, who had been a hostage at Rome,
and he reigned in‡ the one hundred thirty
seventh year of the kingdom of the
Greeks.
11 In those days transgressors of the law
came out of Israel and persuaded many,
saying, “Let’s go make a covenant with
the§ Gentiles around us; for since we
were separated from them many evils
have befallen us.”
12 That proposal was good in their eyes.
13 Some of the people eagerly went to
the king, and he authorized them to
observe the ordinances of the† Gentiles.
14 So‡ they built a gymnasium in
Jerusalem according to the laws of the§
Gentiles.
15 They made themselves
uncircumcised, forsook the holy
covenant, joined themselves to the†
Gentiles, and sold themselves to do evil.
16 The kingdom was established in the
sight of Antiochus, and he planned to
reign over Egypt, that he might reign over
both kingdoms.
17 He entered into Egypt with a‡ great
multitude, with chariots, with elephants,
with cavalry, and with a great§ navy.
18 He made war against Ptolemy king of
Egypt. Ptolemy was put to shame before
him, and fled; and many fell wounded to
death.
19 They took possession of the strong
cities in the land of Egypt, and he took the
spoils of Egypt.
20 Antiochus, after he had defeated
Egypt, returned in† the one hundred forty
third year, and went up against Israel and
Jerusalem with a‡ great multitude,
21 and entered presumptuously into the
sanctuary, and took the golden altar, the
lampstand for the light, and all its utensils.
22 He took the table of the show bread,
the cups for the drink offerings, the bowls,
the golden censers, the veil, the crowns,
and the gold decoration on the front of the
temple. He peeled it all off.
23 He took the silver, the gold, and the
precious vessels. He took the hidden
treasures which he found.
24 When he had taken all of these, he
went away into his own land. He made a

† **1:1** That is, the Greek Empire. Compare 1 Maccabees 1:10 and 1 Maccabees 6:2. ‡ **1:10** circa B.C. 176. § **1:11** Or, *nations:* and so throughout this book. † **1:13** Or, *nations:* and so throughout this book. ‡ **1:14** See 2 Maccabees 4:9, 12. § **1:14** Or, *nations:* and so throughout this book. † **1:15** Or, *nations:* and so throughout this book ‡ **1:17** Gr. *heavy.* § **1:17** Or, *armament* † **1:20** circa B.C. 170. See 2 Maccabees 5:11-16. ‡ **1:20** Gr. *heavy.*

great slaughter, and spoke very arrogantly.
25 Great mourning came upon Israel, in every place where they were.
26 The rulers and elders groaned. The virgins and young men were made feeble. The beauty of the women was changed.
27 Every bridegroom took up lamentation. She who sat in the marriage chamber was mourning.
28 The land was moved for its inhabitants, and all the house of Jacob was clothed with shame.
29 §After two full years, the king sent a chief collector of tribute to the cities of Judah, and he came to Jerusalem with a †great multitude.
30 He spoke words of peace to them in subtlety, and they believed him. Then he fell upon the city suddenly, struck it very severely, and destroyed many people of Israel.
31 He took the spoils of the city, set it on fire, and pulled down its houses and its walls on every side.
32 They led captive the women and the children, and seized the livestock.
33 Then they fortified the city of David with a large, strong wall and with strong towers, and it became their citadel.
34 They put a sinful nation, transgressors of the law, there, and they strengthened themselves in it.
35 They stored up weapons and food, and gathering together the spoils of Jerusalem, they stored them there, and they became a great menace.
36 It became a place to lie in wait against the sanctuary, and an evil adversary to Israel continually.
37 They shed innocent blood on every side of the sanctuary, and defiled the sanctuary.
38 The inhabitants of Jerusalem fled because of them. She became a habitation of foreigners. She became foreign to those who were born in her, and her children forsook her.
39 Her sanctuary was laid waste like a wilderness,‡ her feasts were turned into mourning, her Sabbaths into reproach, and her honor into contempt.
40 According to her glory, so was her dishonor multiplied, and her exaltation was turned into mourning.
41 King Antiochus wrote to his whole kingdom that all should be one people,
42 and that each should forsake his own laws. All the nations agreed according to the word of the king.
43 Many of Israel consented to his worship, sacrificed to the idols, and profaned the Sabbath.
44 The king sent letters by the hand of messengers to Jerusalem and the cities of Judah, that they should follow laws strange to the land,
45 and should forbid whole burnt offerings and sacrifice and drink offerings in the sanctuary; and should profane the Sabbaths and feasts,
46 and pollute the sanctuary and those who were holy;
47 that they should build altars, and temples, and shrines for idols, and should sacrifice swine's flesh and unclean animals;
48 and that they should leave their sons uncircumcised, that they should make their souls abominable with all manner of uncleanness and profanation;
49 so that they might forget the law, and change all the ordinances.
50 Whoever doesn't do according to the word of the king, he shall die.
51 He wrote according to all these words to his whole kingdom. He appointed overseers over all the people, and he commanded the cities of Judah to sacrifice, city by city.
52 From the people were gathered together to them many, everyone who had forsaken the law; and they did evil things in the land.
53 They made Israel to hide themselves in every place of refuge which they had.
54 On the fifteenth day of Chislev, in§ the one hundred forty fifth year, they built an

§ **1:29** See 2 Maccabees 5:24. † **1:29** Gr. *heavy.* ‡ **1:39** See 2 Maccabees 6:6. § **1:54** circa B.C. 168. See 2 Maccabees 5:11.

abomination of desolation upon the altar,† and in the cities of Judah on every side they built idol altars.‡
55 At the doors of the houses and in the streets they burned incense.
56 They tore the books of the law which they found in pieces and set them on fire.
57 Anyone who was found with any a book of the covenant, and if any consented to the law, the king's sentence delivered him to death.
58 Thus did they in their might to Israel, to those who were found month by month in the cities.
59 On the twenty-fifth day of the month they sacrificed upon the idol altar that was on top of the altar of burnt offering.
60 §They put to death women who had circumcised their children, according to the commandment.
61 They hung their babies around their necks, and their houses, and those who had circumcised them.
62 Many in Israel were fully resolved and confirmed in themselves not to eat unclean things.
63 †They chose to die, that they might not be defiled with the food, and that they might not profane the holy covenant; and they died.
64 Exceedingly great wrath came upon Israel.

2

1 In those days Mattathias the son of John, the son of Simeon, a priest of the sons of Joarib, from Jerusalem rose up; and he lived at Modin.
2 And he had five sons:† John, who was surnamed Gaddis;
3 Simon, who was called Thassi;
4 Judas, who was called Maccabaeus;
5 Eleazar, who was called Avaran; and Jonathan, who was called Apphus.
6 He saw the blasphemies that were committed in Judah and in Jerusalem,
7 and he said, "Woe is me! Why was I born to see the destruction of my people and the destruction of the holy city, and to dwell there when it was given into the hand of the enemy, the sanctuary into the hand of foreigners?
8 Her temple has become like a man who was glorious.
9 Her vessels of glory are carried away into captivity. Her infants are slain in her streets. Her young men are slain with the enemy's sword.
10 What nation has not inherited her palaces and taken possession of her spoils?
11 Her adornment has all been taken away. Instead of a free woman, she has become a slave.
12 Behold, our holy things, our beauty, and our glory are laid waste. The Gentiles have profaned them.
13 Why should we live any longer?"
14 Mattathias and his sons tore their clothes, put on sackcloth, and mourned exceedingly.
15 And the king's officers who were enforcing the apostasy came into the city Modin to sacrifice.
16 Many of Israel came to them, and Mattathias and his sons were gathered together.
17 The king's officers answered and spoke to Mattathias, saying, "You are a ruler and an honorable and great man in this city, and strengthened with sons and kindred.
18 Now therefore come first and do the commandment of the king, as all the nations have done, including the men of Judah and those who remain in Jerusalem. You and your house will be numbered among the king's‡ friends, and you and your sons will be honored with silver and gold and many gifts."
19 And Mattathias answered and said with a loud voice, "If all the nations that are in the house of the king's dominion listen to him, to fall away each one from the worship of his fathers, and have chosen to follow his commandments,

† **1:54** The two words rendered *altar* are different in the Greek: and so in 1 Maccabees 1:59. ‡ **1:54** The two words rendered *altar* are different in the Greek: and so in 1 Maccabees 1:59. § **1:60** See 2 Maccabees 6:10. † **1:63** See 2 Maccabees 6:19 and 7:1, etc. † **2:2** Gr. *Joannes.* ‡ **2:18** See 1 Maccabees 3:38; 10:10, etc.; Compare 1 Maccabees 10:65; 11:27; 2 Maccabees 8:9.

20 yet I and my sons and my kindred will
walk in the covenant of our fathers.
21 Far be it from us that we should
forsake the law and the ordinances.
22 We will not listen to the king's words,
to turn aside from our worship, to the
right hand, or to the left."
23 When he had finished speaking these
words, a Jew came in the sight of all to
sacrifice on the altar which was at Modin,
according to the king's commandment.
24 Mattathias saw it, so his zeal was
kindled, and his guts trembled, and he
vented his wrath according to judgment,
and ran and killed him upon the altar.
25 He killed the king's officer, who
compelled men to sacrifice, at the same
time, and pulled down the altar.
26 He was zealous for the law, even as
Phinehas did to Zimri the son of Salu.
27 Mattathias cried out in the city with a
loud voice, saying, "Whoever is zealous
for the law and maintains the covenant,
let him follow me!"
28 He and his sons fled into the
mountains, and left all that they had in
the city.
29 Then many who sought justice and
judgment went down into the wilderness
to live there—
30 they, their children, their wives, and
their livestock—because evils were
multiplied upon them.
31 It was told to the king's officers and
the forces that were in Jerusalem, the city
of David, that certain men who had
broken the king's commandment had
gone down into the secret places in the
wilderness;
32 and many pursued after them, and
having overtaken them, they encamped
against them and set the battle in array
against them on the Sabbath day.
33 They said to them, "Enough of this!
Come out and do according to the word of
the king, and you will all live!"
34 They said, "We won't come out. We
won't do the word of the king, to profane
the Sabbath day."
35 Then the enemy hurried to attack
them.
36 They didn't answer them. They didn't
cast a stone at them, or block their secret
places,
37 saying, "Let's all die in our innocence.
Heaven and earth testify for us, that you
put us to death unjustly."
38 So they attacked them on the Sabbath,
and they died—they, their wives, their
children, and their livestock—in number a
thousand souls of men.
39 When Mattathias and his friends
found out about it, they mourned over
them exceedingly.
40 One said to another, "If we all do as
our kindred have done, and don't fight
against the Gentiles for our lives and our
ordinances, they will quickly destroy us
from off the earth."
41 So they decided that day, saying,
"Whoever comes against us to battle on
the Sabbath day, let's fight against him,
and we will in no way all die, as our
kindred died in the secret places."
42 Then a company of the Hasidaeans,§
mighty men of Israel, everyone who
offered himself willingly for the law, were
gathered together to them.
43 All those who fled from the evils were
added to them, and supported them.
44 They mustered an army, and struck
sinners in their anger, and lawless men in
their wrath. The rest fled to the Gentiles
for safety.
45 And Mattathias and his friends went
around and pulled down the altars.
46 They forcibly circumcised the boys
who were uncircumcised, as many as they
found in the coasts of Israel.
47 They pursued the arrogant, and the
work prospered in their hand.
48 They rescued the law out of the hand
of the Gentiles and out of the hand of the
kings. They never allowed the sinner to
triumph.
49 The days of Mattathias drew near that
he should die, and he said to his sons,
"Now pride and scorn have gained
strength. It is a season of overthrow and
indignant wrath.

§ **2:42** That is, *Chasidim.*

50 Now, my children, be zealous for the
law, and give your lives for the covenant
of your fathers.
51 Call to remembrance the deeds of our
fathers which they did in their
generations; and receive great glory and
an everlasting name.
52 Wasn't Abraham found faithful in
temptation, and it was reckoned to him
for righteousness?
53 Joseph in the time of his distress kept
the commandment, and became lord of
Egypt.
54 Phinehas our father, because he was
exceedingly zealous, obtained the
covenant of an everlasting priesthood.
55 Joshua became a judge in Israel for
fulfilling the word.
56 Caleb obtained a heritage in the land
for testifying in the congregation.
57 David inherited the throne of a
kingdom forever and ever for being
merciful.
58 Elijah was taken up into heaven
because he was exceedingly zealous for
the law.
59 Hananiah, Azariah, and Mishael
believed, and were saved out of the flame.
60 Daniel was delivered from the mouth
of lions for his innocence.
61 "Thus consider from generation to
generation that no one who put their trust
in him will lack for strength.
62 Don't be afraid of the words of a
sinful man; for his glory will be dung and
worms.
63 Today he will be lifted up, and
tomorrow he will in no way be found,
because he has returned to dust, and his
thought has perished.
64 You, my children, be strong, and show
yourselves men on behalf of the law; for
in it you will obtain glory.
65 Behold, Simon your brother, whom I
know to be a man of counsel. Always
listen to him. He shall be a father to you.
66 Judas Maccabaeus has been strong
and mighty from his youth. He shall be
your captain and shall fight† the battle of
the people.
67 Rally around all the doers of the law,
and avenge the wrong done to your
people.
68 Repay the Gentiles, and obey the
commandments of the law."
69 He blessed them, and was gathered to
his ancestors.
70 He died in‡ the one hundred forty
sixth year, and his sons buried him in the
tombs of his ancestors at Modin. All Israel
made great lamentation for him.

3

1 His son Judas, who was called
Maccabaeus, rose up in his place.
2 All his kindred helped him, and so did
all those who joined with his father, and
they fought with gladness the battle of
Israel.
3 He got his people great glory, and put
on a breastplate like a giant, and bound
his warlike harness around him, and set
battles in array, protecting the army with
his sword.
4 He was like a lion in his deeds, and like
a lion's cub roaring for prey.
5 He hunted and pursued the lawless,
and he burned up those who troubled his
people.
6 The lawless shrunk back for fear of
him, and all the workers of lawlessness
were very troubled, and deliverance
prospered in his hand.
7 He angered many kings and made
Jacob glad with his acts. His memory is
blessed forever.
8 He went through the cities of Judah,
destroyed the ungodly out of the land, and
turned away wrath from Israel.
9 He was renowned to the utmost part of
the earth. He gathered together those who
were ready to perish.
10 Apollonius gathered the Gentiles
together with a great army from Samaria
to fight against Israel.
11 Judas learned of it, and he went out to
meet him, struck him, and killed him.
Many fell wounded to death, and the rest
fled.

† **2:66** Some ancient authorities read *you shall fight.*
‡ **2:70** circa B.C. 167.

12 They took their spoils, and Judas took
Apollonius' sword, and he fought with it
all his days.
13 Seron, the commander of the army of
Syria, heard that Judas had gathered a
large company, including a body of
faithful men who stayed with him, went
out to war.
14 He said, "I will make myself a name
and get myself glory in the kingdom. I will
fight against Judas and those who are with
him, who despise the king's command.
15 A mighty army of the ungodly went
up with him to help him, to take
vengeance on the children of Israel.
16 He came near to the ascent of
Bethhoron, and Judas went out to meet
him with a small company.
17 But when they saw the army coming
to meet them, they said to Judas, "What?
Shall we be able, being a small company,
to fight against so great and strong a
multitude? We for our part are faint,
having tasted no food this day."
18 Judas said, "It is an easy thing for
many to be hemmed in by the hands of a
few. With† heaven it is all one, to save by
many or by few;
19 for victory in battle stands not in the
multitude of an army, but strength is from
heaven.
20 They come to us in fullness of
insolence and lawlessness, to destroy us
and our wives and our children, and to
plunder us,
21 but we fight for our lives and our
laws.
22 He himself will crush them before
our face; but as for you, don't be afraid of
them.
23 Now when he had finished speaking,
he rushed suddenly against Seron and his
army, and they were defeated before him.
24 They pursued them down the descent
of Bethhoron to the plain, and about eight
hundred men of them fell; but the rest
fled into the land of the Philistines.
25 The fear of Judas and his kindred, and
the dread of them, began to fall on the
nations around them.
26 His fame reached the king, and every
nation told of the battles of Judas.
27 But when King Antiochus heard these
words, he was full of indignation; and he
sent and gathered together all the forces
of his realm, an exceedingly strong army.
28 He opened his treasury and gave his
forces pay for a year, and commanded
them to be ready for every need.
29 He saw that the money was gone
from his treasures, and that the tributes of
the country were small, because of the
dissension and disaster which he had
brought upon the land, to the end that he
might take away the laws which had been
from the first days.
30 He was afraid that he wouldn't have
enough as at other times for the charges
and the gifts which he used to give with a
liberal hand, more abundantly than the
kings who were before him.
31 And he was exceedingly perplexed in
his mind, and he determined to go into
Persia, and to take the tributes of those
countries, and to gather much money.
32 He left Lysias, an honorable man, and
one of royal lineage, to be over the affairs
of the king from the river Euphrates to the
borders of Egypt,
33 and to bring up his son Antiochus,
until he came again.
34 He delivered to Lysias half of his
forces and the elephants, and gave him
charge of all the things that he would
have done, and concerning those who
lived in Judea and in Jerusalem,
35 that he should send an army against
them to root out and destroy the strength
of Israel and the remnant of Jerusalem,
and to take away their memory from the
place,
36 and that he should make foreigners
live in all their territory, and should
divide their land to them by lot.
37 The king took the half that remained
of the forces, and left Antioch, his royal
city, in the one hundred forty seventh
year;‡ and he passed over the river
Euphrates, and went through the upper

† **3:18** Some ancient authorities read *the God of heaven.*

‡ **3:37** circa B.C. 166.

countries.
38 Lysias chose Ptolemy the son of
Dorymenes, Nicanor, and Gorgias, mighty
men of the king's friends;§
39 and with them, he sent forty thousand
infantry and seven thousand cavalry to go
into the land of Judah and to destroy it,
according to the word of the king.
40 They set out with all their army, and
came and encamped near Emmaus in the
plain country.
41 The merchants of the country heard
of their fame, and took silver and gold in
large quantities, and fetters,† and came
into the camp to take the children of Israel
for slaves. Forces of Syria and of the land
of the Philistines‡ joined with them.
42 Judas and his kindred saw that evils
were multiplied, and that the forces were
encamping in their borders. They learned
about the king's words which he had
commanded, to destroy the people and
make an end of them.
43 Then they each said to his neighbor,
"Let's repair the ruins of our people. Let's
fight for our people and the holy place."
44 The congregation was gathered
together, that they might be ready for
battle, and that they might pray and ask
for mercy and compassion.
45 Jerusalem was without inhabitant
like a wilderness. There was none of her
offspring who went in or went out. The
sanctuary was trampled down. Children
of foreigners were in the citadel. The
Gentiles lived there. Joy was taken away
from Jacob, and the pipe and the harp
ceased.
46 They gathered themselves together,
and came to Mizpeh, near Jerusalem; for
in Mizpeh there used to be a place of
prayer for Israel.
47 They fasted that day, put on
sackcloth, put ashes on their heads, tore
their clothes,
48 and opened the book of the law, to
learn about the things for which the
Gentiles consulted the images of their
idols.
49 They brought the priests' garments,
the first fruits, and the tithes. They stirred
up the Nazarites, who had accomplished
their days.
50 They cried aloud toward heaven,
saying, "What should we do with these
men? Where should we carry them away?
51 Your holy place is trampled down and
profaned. Your priests mourn in
humiliation.
52 Behold, the Gentiles are assembled
together against us to destroy us. You
know what things they imagine against
us.
53 How will we be able to stand against
them, unless you help us?"
54 They sounded with the trumpets, and
gave a loud shout.
55 And after this Judas appointed
leaders of the people: captains of
thousands, captains of hundreds, captains
of fifties, and captains of tens.
56 He said to those who were building
houses, were betrothing wives, were
planting vineyards, and were fearful, that
they should return, each man to his own
house, according to the law.
57 The army marched out and encamped
upon the south side of Emmaus.
58 Judas said, "Arm yourselves and be
valiant men! Be ready in the morning to
fight with these Gentiles who are
assembled together against us to destroy
us and our holy place.
59 For it is better for us to die in battle
than to see the calamities of our nation
and the holy place.
60 Nevertheless, as may be the will in
heaven, so shall he do.

4

1 Gorgias took five thousand infantry, a
thousand chosen cavalry, and the army
moved out at night,
2 that it might fall upon the army of the
Jews and strike them suddenly. The men
of the citadel were his guides.
3 Judas heard of this, and he and the
valiant men moved, that he might strike
the king's army which was at Emmaus

§ **3:38** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. † **3:41** Most of the authorities read *servants.* ‡ **3:41** Gr. *foreigners.*

4 while the forces were still dispersed
from the camp.
5 Gorgias came into the camp of Judas at
night and found no man. He sought them
in the mountains; for he said, “These men
are running away from us.”
6 As soon as it was day, Judas appeared
in the plain with three thousand men.
However they didn’t have the armor and
swords they desired.
7 They saw the camp of the Gentiles
strong and fortified, with cavalry all
around it; and these were expert in war.
8 Judas said to the men who were with
him, “Don’t be afraid of their numbers, or
when they charge.
9 Remember how our fathers were
saved in the Red sea, when Pharaoh
pursued them with an army.
10 Now let’s cry to heaven, if he will
have us, and will remember the covenant
of our fathers, and destroy this army
before our face today.
11 Then all the Gentiles will know that
there is one who redeems and saves
Israel.
12 The foreigners lifted up their eyes,
and saw them coming near them.
13 They went out of the camp to battle.
Those who were with Judas sounded their
trumpets
14 and joined battle. The Gentiles were
defeated, and fled into the plain.
15 But all those in the rear fell by the
sword. They pursued them to† Gazara,
and to the plains of Idumaea, Azotus, and
Jamnia. About three thousand of those
men fell.
16 Then Judas and his army returned
from pursuing them;
17 and he said to the people, “Don’t be
greedy for the spoils, because there is a
battle before us.
18 Gorgias and his army are near us on
the mountain. But stand now against our
enemies and fight against them, and
afterwards take the spoils with boldness.”
19 While Judas was finishing this speech,
a part of them appeared looking out from
the mountain.
20 They saw that their army had been
put to flight, and that the Jews were
burning the camp; for the smoke that was
seen declared what was done.
21 But when they perceived these things,
they were very afraid. Perceiving also the
army of Judas in the plain ready for battle,
22 they all fled into the land of the‡
Philistines.
23 Judas returned to plunder the camp,
and they took much gold, silver, blue, sea
purple, and great riches.
24 Then they returned home, and sang a
song of thanksgiving, and gave praise to
heaven, because he is good, because his
mercy endures forever.
25 Israel had a great deliverance that
day.
26 The foreigners who had escaped
came and told Lysias all the things that
had happened.
27 When he heard of it, he was
confounded and discouraged, because the
things he desired had not been done to
Israel, nor had such things happened as
the king commanded him.
28 In the next year, he gathered together
sixty thousand chosen infantry and five
thousand cavalry, that he might subdue
them.
29 They came into Idumaea and
encamped at Bethsura. Judas met them
with ten thousand men.
30 He saw that the army was strong, and
he prayed and said, “Blessed are you, O
Savior of Israel, who defeated the attack
of the mighty warrior by the hand of your
servant David, and delivered the army of
the§ Philistines into the hands of Jonathan
the son of Saul, and of his armor bearer.
31 Hem in this army in the hand of your
people Israel, and let them be ashamed
for their army and their cavalry.
32 Give them faintness of heart. Cause
the boldness of their strength to melt
away, and let them quake at their
destruction.
33 Strike them down with the sword of
those who love you, and let all who know
your name praise you with thanksgiving.”

† **4:15** Gr. *Gazera.* ‡ **4:22** Gr. *foreigners.* § **4:30** Gr. *foreigners.*

34 They joined in battle; and about five
thousand men of Lysias' army fell. They
fell down near them.
35 But when Lysias saw that his troops
were put to flight, and the boldness that
had come upon those who were with
Judas, and how they were ready either to
live or to die nobly, he withdrew to
Antioch, and gathered together hired
soldiers, that he might come again into
Judea with an even greater army.
36 But Judas and his kindred said,
"Behold, our enemies are defeated. Let's
go up to cleanse the holy place and to
rededicate it."
37 All the army was gathered together,
and they went up to mount Zion.
38 They saw the sanctuary laid desolate,
the altar profaned, the gates burned up,
shrubs growing in the courts as in a forest
or as on one of the mountains, and the
priests' chambers pulled down;
39 and they tore their clothes, made
great lamentation, put ashes upon their
heads,
40 fell on their faces to the ground, †blew
with the solemn trumpets,‡ and cried
toward heaven.
41 Then Judas appointed certain men to
fight against those who were in the citadel
until he had cleansed the holy place.
42 He chose blameless priests who were
devoted to the law;
43 and they cleansed the holy place and
carried the defiled stones out to an
unclean place.
44 They deliberated what to do with the
altar of burnt offerings, which had been
profaned.
45 A good plan came into their mind,
that they should pull it down, lest it would
be a reproach to them, because the
Gentiles had defiled it. So they pulled
down the altar
46 and laid up the stones on the temple
hill in a convenient place, until a prophet
would come to give an answer concerning
them.
47 They took whole stones according to
the law, and built a new altar like the
former.
48 They built the holy place and the
inner parts of the house; and they
consecrated the courts.
49 They made new holy vessels, and they
brought the lampstand, the altar of
incense, and the table into the temple.
50 They burned incense on the altar, and
they lit the lamps that were upon the
lampstand, and they gave light in the
temple.
51 They set loaves upon the table, hung
up the curtains, and finished all the work
which they had done.
52 They rose up early in the morning, on
the twenty-fifth day of the ninth month,
which is the month Chislev, in§ the one
hundred forty eighth year,
53 and offered sacrifice according to the
law on the new altar of burnt offerings
which they had made.
54 At the time and day the Gentiles had
profaned it, even then it was dedicated
with songs, harps, lutes, and with
cymbals.
55 All the people fell on their faces,
worshiped, and gave praise toward
heaven, which had given them good
success.
56 They celebrated the dedication of the
altar eight days, and offered burnt
offerings with gladness, and sacrificed a
sacrifice of deliverance and praise.
57 They decorated the front of the
temple with crowns of gold and small
shields. They dedicated the gates and the
priests' chambers, and made doors for
them.
58 There was exceedingly great gladness
among the people, and the reproach of the
Gentiles was turned away.
59 Judas and his kindred and the whole
congregation of Israel ordained that the
days of the dedication of the altar should
be kept in their seasons from year to year
for eight days, from the twenty-fifth day of
the month Chislev, with gladness and joy.
60 At that time, they fortified mount
Zion with high walls and strong towers

† **4:40** Compare Numbers 31:6. ‡ **4:40** Gr. *trumpets of signals.* § **4:52** circa B.C. 165.

around it, lest perhaps the Gentiles might come and trample them down, as they had done before.
61 Judas stationed a garrison to guard it. They fortified Bethsura to keep it, that the people might have a stronghold near Idumaea.

5

1 It came to pass, when the Gentiles all around heard that the altar had been rebuilt and the sanctuary dedicated as before, they were exceedingly angry.
2 They took counsel to destroy the race of Jacob that was in the midst of them, and they began to kill and destroy among the people.
3 Judas fought against the children of Esau in Idumaea at Akrabattine, because they besieged Israel. He struck them with a great slaughter, humbled them, and took their spoils.
4 He remembered the wickedness of the children of† Baean, who were a snare and a stumbling block to the people, lying in wait for them on the highways.
5 They were shut up by him in the towers. He encamped against them, and destroyed them utterly, and burned with fire the towers of the place with all who were in them.
6 He passed over to the children of Ammon, and found a mighty band and many people, with Timotheus for their leader.
7 He fought many battles with them, and they were defeated before his face. He struck them,
8 and took possession of Jazer and its villages,‡ and returned again into Judea.
9 The Gentiles who were in Gilead gathered themselves together against the Israelites who were on their borders, to destroy them. They fled to the stronghold of Dathema,
10 and sent letters to Judas and his kindred, saying, "The Gentiles who are around us are gathered together against us to destroy us.
11 They are preparing to come and get possession of the stronghold where we fled for refuge, and Timotheus is the leader of their army.
12 Now therefore come and deliver us from their hand, for many of us have fallen.
13 All our kindred who were in the land of §Tubias have been put to death. They have carried their wives, their children, and their stuff into captivity. They destroyed about a thousand men there."
14 While the letters were still being read, behold, other messengers came from Galilee with their clothes torn, bringing a similar report,
15 saying, "People of Ptolemais, of Tyre, of Sidon, and all Galilee of the† Gentiles have gathered together to destroy us."
16 Now when Judas and the people heard these words, a great congregation assembled together to determine what they should do for their kindred who were in distress and under attack.
17 Judas said to Simon his brother, "Choose men and go deliver your kindred who are in Galilee, but Jonathan my brother and I will go into the land of Gilead."
18 He left Joseph the son of Zacharias, and Azarias, as leaders of the people, with the remnant of the army, in Judea, to guard it.
19 He commanded them, saying, "Take charge of this people, and fight no battle with the Gentiles until we return."
20 Then three thousand men were assigned to go into Galilee with Simon, but eight thousand men were assigned to Judas to go into the land of Gilead.
21 Simon went into Galilee and fought many battles with the Gentiles, and the Gentiles were defeated before him.
22 He pursued them to the gate of Ptolemais. About three thousand men of the Gentiles fell, and he took their spoils.
23 They took to them those who were in Galilee and in Arbatta, with their wives, their children, and all that they had, and

† **5:4** Compare 2 Maccabees 10:18-23. ‡ **5:8** Gr. *daughters.* Compare Numbers 21:25. § **5:13** Compare 2 Maccabees 12:17. † **5:15** Gr. *foreigners.*

brought them into Judea with great gladness.
24 Judas Maccabaeus and his brother Jonathan passed over the Jordan, and went three days' journey in the wilderness.
25 They met with the Nabathaeans, and these met them in a peaceful manner and told them all things that had happened to their kindred in the land of Gilead,
26 and how many of them were shut up in Bosora, Bosor, Alema,‡ Casphor, Maked, and§ Carnaim—all these cities are strong and large—
27 and how they were shut up in the rest of the cities of the land of Gilead, and that tomorrow they planned to encamp against the strongholds, and to take them, and to destroy all these men in one day.
28 Judas and his army turned suddenly by the way of the wilderness to Bosora; and he took the city, and killed all the males with the edge of the sword, took all their spoils, and burned the city with fire.
29 He left there at night, and went until he came to the stronghold.
30 When the morning came, they lifted up their eyes and saw many people who couldn't be counted, bearing ladders and engines of war, to take the stronghold; and they were fighting against them.
31 Judas saw that the battle had begun, and that the cry of the city went up to heaven, with trumpets and a great sound,
32 and he said to the men of his army, "Fight today for your kindred!"
33 Then he went out behind them in three companies. They sounded with their trumpets and cried out in prayer.
34 And the army of Timotheus perceived that it was Maccabaeus, and they fled from before him. He struck them with a great slaughter. About eight thousand men of them fell on that day.
35 He turned away to Mizpeh and fought against it, took it, killed all its males, took its spoils, and burned it with fire.
36 From there he marched and took† Casphor, Maked, Bosor, and the other cities of the land of Gilead.
37 Now after these things, Timotheus gathered another army and encamped near Raphon beyond the brook.
38 Judas sent men to spy on the army; and they brought him word, saying, "All the Gentiles who are around us are gathered together to them, an exceedingly great army.
39 They have hired Arabians to help them, and are encamped beyond the brook, ready to come against you to battle." So Judas went to meet them.
40 Timotheus said to the captains of his army when Judas and his army drew near to the brook of water, "If he crosses over to us first, we won't be able to withstand him, for he will certainly defeat us;
41 but if he is afraid, and encamps beyond the river, we will cross over to him, and defeat him."
42 Now when Judas came near to the water brook, he caused the scribes of the people to remain by the brook, and commanded them, saying, "Allow no man to encamp, but let all come to the battle."
43 Then he crossed over against them first, and all the people after him; and all the Gentiles were defeated before his face, and threw away their weapons, and fled to the temple at ‡Carnaim.
44 They took the city and burned the temple with fire, together with all who were in it. Carnaim was subdued. They couldn't stand any longer before the face of Judas.
45 Judas gathered together all Israel, those who were in the land of Gilead, from the least to the greatest, with their wives, their children, and their stuff, an exceedingly great army, that they might come into the land of Judah.
46 They came as far as Ephron, and this same city was large and very strong. It was on the road where they were going. They couldn't turn away from it on the right hand or on the left, but needed to pass through the middle of it.

‡ **5:26** Compare 2 Maccabees 12:13. § **5:26** compare 2 Maccabees 12:21. † **5:36** See 1 Maccabees 5:26 ‡ **5:43** See 1 Maccabees 5:26.

47 The people of the city shut them out
and blocked the gates with stones.
48 Judas sent to them with words of
peace, saying, “We will pass through your
land to go into our own land, and no one
will harm you. We will only pass by on
our feet.” But they wouldn’t open to him.
49 Then Judas commanded
proclamation to be made in the army, that
each man should encamp in the place
where he was.
50 So the men of the army encamped,
and fought against the city all that day
and all that night, and the city was
delivered into his hands.
51 He destroyed all the males with the
edge of the sword, razed the city, took its
plunder, and passed through the city over
those who were slain.
52 They went over the Jordan into the
great plain near Bethshan.
53 And Judas gathered together those
who lagged behind and encouraged the
people all the way through, until he came
into the land of Judah.
54 They went up to mount Zion with
gladness and joy, and offered whole burnt
offerings, because not so much as one of
them was slain until they returned in
peace.
55 In the days when Judas and Jonathan
were in the land of Gilead, and Simon his
brother in Galilee before Ptolemais,
56 Joseph the son of Zacharias, and
Azarias, rulers of the army, heard of their
exploits and of the war, and what things
they had done.
57 They said, “Let’s also get us a name,
and let’s go fight against the Gentiles who
are around us.”
58 So they gave orders to the men of the
army that was with them, and went
toward Jamnia.
59 Gorgias and his men came out of the
city to meet them in battle.
60 Joseph and Azarias were put to flight,
and were pursued to the borders of Judea.
About two thousand men of Israel fell on
that day.
61 There was a great overthrow among
the people, because they didn’t listen to
Judas and his kindred, thinking to do
some exploit.
62 But they were not of the family of
those men by whose hand deliverance
was given to Israel.
63 The man Judas and his kindred were
glorified exceedingly in the sight of all
Israel, and of all the Gentiles, wherever
their name was heard of.
64 Men gathered together to them,
acclaiming them.
65 Judas and his kindred went out and
fought against the children of Esau in the
land toward the south. He struck Hebron
and its villages,§ pulled down its
strongholds, and burned its towers all
around.
66 He marched to go into the land of the†
Philistines, and he went through‡
Samaria.
67 In that day certain priests, desiring to
do exploits there, were slain in battle,
when they went out to battle unadvisedly.
68 But Judas turned toward Azotus, to
the land of the§ Philistines, pulled down
their altars, burned the carved images of
their gods with fire, took the plunder of
their cities, and returned into the land of
Judah.

6

1 King Antiochus was traveling through
the upper countries; and he heard that in
Elymais in Persia there was a city
renowned for riches, for silver and gold,
2 and that the temple which was in it
was exceedingly rich, and that in it were
golden shields, breastplates, and weapons
which Alexander, son of Philip, the
Macedonian king, who reigned first
among the Greeks, left behind there.
3 So he came and tried to take the city
and to pillage it; and he was not able,
because his plan was known to them of
the city,

§ **5:65** Gr. *daughters.* Compare Numbers 21:25. † **5:66** Gr. *foreigners.* ‡ **5:66** Or, *Marisa* See Josephus, Antiquities 12:8. 6, and 2 Maccabees 12:35. § **5:68** Gr. *foreigners.*

4 and they rose up against him in battle. He fled and returned to Babylon with great disappointment.

5 Then someone came into Persia bringing him news that the armies which went against the land of Judah had been put to flight,

6 and that Lysias went first with a strong army and was put to shame before them, and that they had grown strong because of weapons, power, and a supply of plunder which they took from the armies that they had cut off,

7 and that they had pulled down the abomination which he had built upon the altar that was in Jerusalem, and that they had surrounded the sanctuary with high walls, as before, and also Bethsura, his city.

8 It came to pass, when the king heard these words, he was astonished and moved exceedingly. He laid himself down on his bed, and fell sick for grief, because it had not turned out for him as he had planned.

9 He was there many days, because great grief continually gripped him, and he realized that he would die.

10 He called for all his† friends, and said to them, “Sleep departs from my eyes, and my heart fails because of worry.

11 I said in my heart, ‘To what suffering I have come! How great a flood it is that I’m in, now! For I was gracious and loved in my power.’

12 But now I remember the evils which I did at Jerusalem, and that I took all the vessels of silver and gold that were in it, and sent out to destroy the inhabitants of Judah without a cause.

13 I perceive that it is because of this that these evils have come upon me. Behold, I am perishing through great grief in a strange land.”

14 Then he called for Philip, one of his‡ friends, and set him over all his kingdom.

15 He gave him his crown, his robe, and his signet ring, so that he could guide Antiochus his son, and nourish him up that he might be king.

16 Then King Antiochus died there in the one hundred forty-ninth year.§

17 When Lysias learned that the king was dead, he set up Antiochus his son to reign, whom he had nourished up being young, and he called his name Eupator.

18 Those who were in the citadel kept hemming Israel in around the sanctuary, and always sought to harm them and to strengthen the Gentiles.

19 Judas planned to destroy them, and called all the people together to besiege them.

20 They were gathered together, and besieged them in† the one hundred fiftieth year, and he made mounds to shoot from, and engines of war.

21 Some of those who were hemmed in came out, and some of the ungodly men of Israel were joined to them.

22 They went to the king, and said, “How long will you not execute judgment, and avenge our kindred?

23 We were willing to serve your father and to live by his words, and to follow his commandments.

24 Because of this, the children of our people besieged the citadel‡ and were alienated from us; but as many of us as they could catch, they killed, and plundered our inheritances.

25 Not against us only did they stretch out their hand, but also against all their borders.

26 Behold, they are encamped this day against the citadel at Jerusalem to take it. They have fortified the sanctuary and Bethsura.

27 If you don’t quickly prevent them, they will do greater things than these, and you won’t be able to control them.

28 When the king heard this, he was angry, and gathered together all his§ friends, the rulers of his army, and those who were over the cavalry.

29 Bands of hired soldiers came to him from other kingdoms and from islands of

† **6:10** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. ‡ **6:14** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. § **6:16** Circa B.C. 164. † **6:20** circa B.C. 163.
‡ **6:24** Gr. *it.* § **6:28** See 1 Maccabees 2:18.

the sea.
30 The number of his forces was one
hundred thousand infantry, and twenty
thousand cavalry, and thirty-two
elephants trained for war.
31 They went through Idumaea, and
encamped against Bethsura, and fought
against it many days, and made engines of
war. The Jews came out and burned them
with fire, and fought valiantly.
32 Judas marched away from the citadel
and encamped at Bethzacharias, near the
king's camp.
33 The king rose early in the morning,
and marched his army† at full speed along
the road to Bethzacharias. His forces
made themselves ready to battle and
sounded their trumpets.
34 They offered the elephants the juice
of grapes and mulberries, that they might
prepare them for the battle.
35 They distributed the animals among
the phalanxes. They set by each elephant
a thousand men armed with coats of mail
and helmets of brass on their heads. Five
hundred chosen cavalry were appointed
for each elephant.
36 These were ready beforehand,
wherever the elephant was. Wherever
the elephant went, they went with it. They
didn't leave it.
37 Strong, covered wooden towers were
upon them, one upon each elephant,
fastened upon it with secure harnesses.
Upon each were four valiant men who
fought upon them, beside his Indian
driver.
38 The rest of the cavalry he set on this
side and that side on the two flanks of the
army, striking terror into the enemy, and
protected by the phalanxes.
39 Now when the sun shone upon the
shields of gold and brass, the mountains
lit up, and blazed like flaming torches.
40 A part of the king's army was spread
upon the high hills and some on the low
ground, and they went on firmly and in
order.
41 All who heard the noise of their
multitude, the marching of the multitude,
and the rattling of the weapons trembled;
for the army was exceedingly great and
strong.
42 Judas and his army drew near for
battle, and six hundred men of the king's
army fell.
43 Eleazar, who was called Avaran, saw
one of the animals armed with royal
breastplates, and it was taller than all the
animals, and the king seemed to be on it.
44 He gave his life to deliver his people,
and to get himself an everlasting name.
45 He ran upon him courageously into
the midst of the phalanx, and killed on the
right hand and on the left, and they parted
away from him on this side and on that.
46 He crept under the elephant, and
stabbed it from beneath, and killed it. The
elephant fell to the earth upon him, and
he died there.
47 They saw the strength of the kingdom
and the fierce attack of the army, and
turned away from them.

48 But the soldiers of the king's army
went up to Jerusalem to meet them, and
the king encamped toward Judea and
toward mount Zion.
49 He made peace with the people of
Bethsura. He came out of the city because
they had no food there to endure the
siege, because it was a Sabbath to the land.
50 The king took Bethsura, and
appointed a garrison there to keep it.
51 He encamped against the sanctuary
many days; and set there mounds to shoot
from, and engines of war, and machines
for throwing fire and stones, and
weapons to throw darts, and slings.
52 The Jews also made engines of war
against their engines, and fought for
many days.
53 But there was no food in the
sanctuary, because it was the seventh
year, and those who fled for safety into
Judea from among the Gentiles had eaten
up the rest of the stores.
54 There were only a few people left in
the sanctuary, because the famine
prevailed against them, and they were
scattered, each man to his own place.

† **6:33** Or, *itself eager for the fight*

55 Lysias heard that Philip, whom
Antiochus the king, while he was yet alive,
appointed to raise his son Antiochus to be
king,
56 had returned from Persia and Media,
and with him the forces that went with
the king, and that he was seeking to take
control of the government.
57 He made haste, and gave orders to
depart. He said to the king and the leaders
of the army and to the men, "We get
weaker daily, our food is scant, the place
where we encamp is strong, and the
affairs of the kingdom lie upon us.
58 Now therefore let's negotiate with
these men, and make peace with them
and with all their nation,
59 and covenant with them, that they
may walk after their own laws, as before;
for because of their laws which we
abolished they were angered, and did all
these things."
60 The speech pleased the king and the
princes, and he sent to them to make
peace; and they accepted it.
61 The king and the princes swore to
them. On these conditions, they came out
from the stronghold.
62 Then the king entered into mount
Zion. He saw the strength of the place,
and broke the oath which he had sworn,
and gave orders to pull down the wall all
around.
63 Then he left in haste and returned to
Antioch, and found Philip master of the
city. He fought against him, and took the
city by force.

7

1 In the one hundred fifty first year,† Demetrius the son of Seleucus came out of Rome, and went up with a few men to a city by the sea, and reigned there.
2 It came to pass, when he would go into the house of the kingdom of his fathers, that the army laid hands on Antiochus and Lysias, to bring them to him.
3 The thing became known to him, and he said, "Don't show me their faces!"
4 So the army killed them. Then Demetrius sat upon the throne of his kingdom.
5 All the lawless and ungodly men of Israel came to him. Alcimus was their leader, desiring to be high priest.
6 They accused the people to the king, saying, "Judas and his kindred have destroyed all your friends, and have scattered us from our own land.
7 Now therefore send a man whom you trust, and let him go and see all the destruction which he has brought on us and the king's country, and how he has punished them and all who helped them."
8 So the king chose Bacchides, one of the king's‡ friends, who was ruler in the country beyond the river, and was a great man in the kingdom, and faithful to the king.
9 He sent him and that ungodly Alcimus, whom he made the high priest; and he commanded him to take vengeance upon the children of Israel.
10 They marched away and came with a great army into the land of Judah. He sent messengers to Judas and his kindred with words of peace deceitfully.
11 They paid no attention to their words; for they saw that they had come with a great army.
12 A group of scribes gathered together to Alcimus and Bacchides to seek just terms.
13 The§ Hasidaeans were the first among the children of Israel who sought peace from them,
14 for they said, "One who is a priest of the seed of Aaron has come with the army, and he will do us no wrong."
15 He spoke with them words of peace, and swore to them, saying, "We won't seek to harm you or your friends."
16 They trusted him. Then he seized sixty men of them, and killed them in one day, according to the word which was written,
17 †The flesh of your saints
and their blood was shed all around
Jerusalem,

† **7:1** circa B.C. 162. ‡ **7:8** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. § **7:13** That is, Chasidim. † **7:17** Psalms 79:2, 3.

and there was no one to bury them.
18 The fear and the dread of them fell
upon all the people, for they said, “There
is neither truth nor justice in them; for
they have broken the covenant and the
oath which they swore.”
19 Bacchides withdrew from Jerusalem,
and encamped in Bezeth. He sent and
seized many of the deserters who were
with him, and some of the people, and he
killed them, throwing them into a large
pit.
20 He placed Alcimus in charge of the
country and left with him a force to aid
him. Then Bacchides went away to the
king.
21 Alcimus struggled to maintain his
high priesthood.
22 All those who troubled their people
joined him, and they took control of the
land of Judah, and did great damage in
Israel.
23 Judas saw all the wrongs that Alcimus
and his company had done among the
children of Israel, even more than the
Gentiles.
24 He went out into all the borders of
Judea and took vengeance on the men
who had deserted from him, and they
were restrained from going out into the
country.
25 But when Alcimus saw that Judas and
his company had grown strong, and knew
that he was not able to withstand them, he
returned to the king, and brought evil
accusations against them.
26 ‡Then the king sent Nicanor, one of
his honorable princes, a man who hated
Israel and was their enemy, and
commanded him to destroy the people.
27 Nicanor came to Jerusalem with a
great army. He sent to Judas and his
kindred deceitfully with words of peace,
saying,
28 “Let there be no battle between me
and you; I will come with a few men, that I
may see your faces in peace.”
29 He came to Judas, and they saluted
one another peaceably. The enemies were
ready to seize Judas by violence.
30 This was known to Judas, that he
came to him with deceit, and he was very
afraid of him, and would see his face no
more.
31 Nicanor found out that his plan was
disclosed; and he went out to meet Judas
in battle beside Capharsalama.
32 About five hundred men of Nicanor’s
army fell, and the rest fled into the city of
David.
33 After these things, Nicanor went up to
mount Zion. Some of the priests came out
of the sanctuary, with some of the elders
of the people, to salute him peaceably, and
to show him the whole burned sacrifice
that was being offered for the king.
34 He mocked them, laughed at them,
derided them shamefully,§ spoke
arrogantly,
35 and swore in a rage, saying, “Unless
Judas and his army are now delivered
into my hands, it shall be that, if I return
safely, I will burn up this house!” And he
went out in a great rage.
36 The priests entered in, and stood
before the altar and the temple; and they
wept, and said,
37 “You chose this house to be called by
your name, to be a house of prayer and
supplication for your people.
38 Take vengeance on this man and his
army, and let them fall by the sword.
Remember their blasphemies, and don’t
allow them to live any longer.”
39 Then Nicanor went out from
Jerusalem and encamped in Bethhoron,
and there the Syrian army met him.
40 Judas encamped in Adasa with three
thousand men. Judas prayed and said,
41 “When those who came from the king
blasphemed, your angel went out, and
struck among them one hundred
eighty-five thousand.
42 Even so, crush this army before us
today, and let all the rest know that he has
spoken wickedly against your sanctuary.
Judge him according to his wickedness.”
43 On the thirteenth day of the month
Adar, the armies met in battle. Nicanor’s

‡ **7:26** See 2 Maccabees 14:12. § **7:34** Gr. *polluted them.*

army was defeated, and he himself was the first to fall in the battle.
44 Now when his army saw that Nicanor had fallen, they threw away their weapons and fled.
45 They pursued them a day's journey from Adasa until you come to† Gazara, and they sounded an alarm after them with the signal trumpets.
46 Men came out of all the surrounding villages of Judea, and outflanked them. These turned them back on those, and they all fell by the sword. There wasn't one of them left.
47 The Jews took the spoils and the booty, and they cut off Nicanor's head and his right hand, which he had stretched out so arrogantly, and brought them, and hung them up beside Jerusalem.
48 The people were exceedingly glad, and they kept that day as a day of great gladness.
49 ‡They ordained to keep this day year by year on the thirteenth day of Adar.
50 So the land of Judah had rest a few days.

8

1 Judas heard of the fame of the Romans, that they are valiant men, and have pleasure in all who join themselves to them, and make friends with all who come to them,
2 and that they are valiant men. They told him of their wars and exploits which they do among the Gauls, and how they conquered them, and forced them to pay tribute;
3 and what things they did in the land of Spain, that they might take control of the silver and gold mines which were there;
4 and how by their policy and persistence they conquered all the place (and the place was exceedingly far from them), and the kings who came against them from the uttermost part of the earth, until they had defeated them, and struck them severely; and how the rest give them tribute year by year.
5 Philip, and Perseus, king of Chittim, and those who lifted up themselves against them, they defeated in battle, and conquered them.
6 Antiochus also, the great king of Asia, came against them to battle, having one hundred twenty elephants, with cavalry, chariots, and an exceedingly great army, and he was defeated by them.
7 They took him alive, and decreed that both he and those who reigned after him should give them a great tribute, and should give hostages, and a parcel of land from the best of their provinces:
8 the countries of India, Media, and Lydia. They took them from him, and gave them to King Eumenes.
9 Judas heard how the Greeks planned to come and destroy them,
10 but this became known to them, and they sent against them a general who fought against them, and many of them fell down wounded to death, and they made captive their wives and their children, and plundered them, and conquered their land, and pulled down their strongholds, and plundered them, and brought them into bondage to this day.
11 The remaining kingdoms and islands, as many as rose up against them at any time, they destroyed and made them to be their servants;
12 but with their friends and those who relied on them they stayed friends. They conquered the kingdoms that were near and those that were far off, and all that heard of their fame were afraid of them.
13 Moreover, whoever they desired to help and to make kings, these they make kings; and whoever they desired, they depose. They are exalted exceedingly.
14 For all this, none of them ever put on a crown, neither did they clothe themselves with purple, as a display of grandeur.
15 Judas heard how they had made for themselves a senate house, and day by day, three hundred twenty men sat in council, consulting always for the people, to the end they might be well governed,

† **7:45** Gr. *Gazera.* ‡ **7:49** See 2 Maccabees 15:36.

16 and how they commit their
government to one man year by year, that
he should rule over them, and control all
their country, and all are obedient to that
one, and there is neither envy nor
emulation among them.
17 So Judas chose Eupolemus the son of
John, the son of Accos, and Jason the son
of Eleazar, and sent them to Rome, to
establish friendship and alliance with
them,
18 and that they should free the yoke
from themselves; for they saw that the
kingdom of the Greeks kept Israel in
bondage.
19 Then they went to Rome, a very long
journey, and they entered into the senate
house, and said,
20 "Judas, who is also called
Maccabaeus, and his kindred, and the
people of the Jews, have sent us to you, to
make an alliance and peace with you, and
that we might be registered as your allies
and friends."
21 This thing was pleasing to them.
22 This is the copy of the writing which
they wrote back again on tables of brass,
and sent to Jerusalem, that it might be
with them there for a memorial of peace
and alliance:
23 "Good success be to the Romans, and
to the nation of the Jews, by sea and by
land forever. May the sword and the
enemy be far from them.
24 But if war arises for Rome first, or any
of their allies in all their dominion,
25 the nation of the Jews shall help them
as allies, as the occasion shall indicate to
them, with all their heart.
26 To those who make war upon them,
they shall not give supplies, food,
weapons, money, or ships, as it has
seemed good to Rome, and they shall keep
their ordinances without taking anything
in return.
27 In the same way, moreover, if war
comes first upon the nation of the Jews,
the Romans shall willingly help them as
allies, as the occasion shall indicate to
them;
28 and to those who are fighting with
them, there shall not be given food,
weapons, money, or ships, as it has
seemed good to Rome. They shall keep
these ordinances, and that without deceit.
29 According to these terms, the Romans
made a treaty with the Jewish people.
30 But if hereafter the one party and the
other shall determine to add or diminish
anything, they shall do it at their pleasure,
and whatever they add or take away shall
be ratified.
31 Concerning the evils which King
Demetrius is doing to them, we have
written to him, saying, 'Why have you
made your yoke heavy on our friends and
allies the Jews?
32 If therefore they plead any more
against you, we will do them justice, and
fight with you on sea and on land.' "

9

1 Demetrius heard that Nicanor had
fallen with his forces in battle, and he sent
Bacchides and Alcimus again into the land
of Judah a second time, and the right wing
of his army with them.
2 They went by the way that leads to
Gilgal, and encamped against Mesaloth,
which is in Arbela, and took possession of
it, and killed many people.
3 The first month of the one hundred
fifty-second year, †they encamped against
Jerusalem.
4 Then they marched away and went to
Berea with twenty thousand infantry and
two thousand cavalry.
5 Judas was encamped at Elasa with
three thousand chosen men.
6 They saw the multitude of the forces,
that they were many, and they were
terrified. Many slipped away out of the
army. There were not left of them more
than eight hundred men.
7 Judas saw that his army slipped away
and that the battle pressed upon him, and
he was very troubled in spirit, because he
had no time to gather them together, and
he became faint.
8 He said to those who were left, "Let's
arise and go up against our adversaries, if

† **9:3** circa B.C. 161.

perhaps we may be able to fight with them."

9 They tried to dissuade him, saying, "There is no way we are able; but let's rather save our lives now. Let's return again with our kindred, and fight against them; but we are too few."

10 Judas said, "Let it not be so that I should do this thing, to flee from them. If our time has come, let's die in a manly way for our kindred's sake, and not leave a cause of reproach against our honor."

11 The army marched out from the camp, and stood to encounter them. The cavalry was divided into two companies, and the slingers and the archers went before the army, and all the mighty men that fought in the front of the battle.

12 Bacchides was in the right wing. The phalanx advanced on the two parts, and they blew with their trumpets.

13 The men by Judas' side sounded with their trumpets, and the earth shook with the shout of the armies, and the battle was joined, and continued from morning until evening.

14 Judas saw that Bacchides and the strength of his army were on the right side, and all that were brave in heart went with him,

15 and the right wing was defeated by them, and he pursued after them to the mount Azotus.

16 Those who were on the left wing saw that the right wing was defeated, and they turned and followed in the footsteps of Judas and of those who were with him.

17 The battle became desperate, and many on both sides fell wounded to death.

18 Judas fell, and the rest fled.

19 Jonathan and Simon took Judas their brother, and buried him in the tomb of his ancestors at Modin.

20 They wept for him. All Israel made great lamentation for him, and mourned many days, and said,

21 "How the mighty has fallen, the savior of Israel!"

22 The rest of the acts of Judas, and his wars, and the valiant deeds which he did, and his greatness, are not written; for they were exceedingly many.

23 It came to pass after the death of Judas, that the lawless emerged within all the borders of Israel. All those who did iniquity rose up.

24 In those days there was an exceedingly great famine, and the country went over to their side.

25 Bacchides chose the ungodly men and made them rulers of the country.

26 They inquired and searched for the friends of Judas, and brought them to Bacchides, and he took vengeance on them and used them spitefully.

27 There was great suffering in Israel, such as was not since the time prophets stopped appearing to them.

28 All the friends of Judas were gathered together, and they said to Jonathan,

29 "Since your brother Judas has died, we have no man like him to go out against our enemies and Bacchides, and among those of our nation who hate us.

30 Now therefore we have chosen you this day to be our prince and leader in his place, that you may fight our battles."

31 So Jonathan took the governance upon him at that time, and rose up in the place of his brother Judas.

32 When Bacchides found out, he tried to kill him.

33 Jonathan, and Simon his brother, and all who were with him, knew it; and they fled into the wilderness of Tekoah, and encamped by the water of the pool of Asphar.

34 Bacchides found this out on the Sabbath day, and came—he and all his army—over the Jordan.

35 Jonathan sent his brother, a leader of the multitude, and implored his friends the Nabathaeans, that they might store their baggage, which was much, with them.

36 The children of Jambri came out of Medaba, and seized John and all that he had, and went their way with it.

37 But after these things, they brought word to Jonathan and Simon his brother that the children of Jambri were

celebrating a great wedding, and were bringing the bride, a daughter of one of the great nobles of Canaan, from Nadabath with a large escort.
38 They remembered John their brother, and went up, and hid themselves under the cover of the mountain.
39 They lifted up their eyes and looked, and saw a great procession with much baggage. The bridegroom came out with his friends and his kindred to meet them with timbrels, musicians, and many weapons.
40 They rose up against them from their ambush and killed them, and many fell wounded to death. The remnant fled into the mountain, and the Jews took all their spoils.
41 So the wedding was turned into mourning, and the voice of their musicians into lamentation.
42 They avenged fully the blood of their brother, and turned back to the marshes of the Jordan.
43 Bacchides heard it, and he came on the Sabbath day to the banks of the Jordan with a great army.
44 Jonathan said to his company, "Let's stand up now and fight for our lives, for things are different today than they were yesterday and the day before.
45 For, behold, the battle is before us and behind us. Moreover the water of the Jordan is on this side and on that side, and marsh and thicket. There is no place to escape.
46 Now therefore cry to heaven, that you may be delivered out of the hand of your enemies."
47 So the battle was joined, and Jonathan stretched out his hand to strike Bacchides, and he turned away back from him.
48 Jonathan and those who were with him leapt into the Jordan, and swam over to the other side. The enemy didn't pass over the Jordan against them.
49 About a thousand men of Bacchides' company fell that day;
50 and he returned to Jerusalem. They built strong cities in Judea, the stronghold that was in Jericho, and Emmaus, Bethhoron, Bethel, Timnath, Pharathon, and Tephon, with high walls and gates and bars.
51 He set garrisons in them to harass Israel.
52 He fortified the city Bethsura, Gazara, and the citadel, and put troops and stores of food in them.
53 He took the sons of the chief men of the country for hostages, and put them under guard in the citadel at Jerusalem.

54 And in the one hundred fifty-third year,‡ in the second month, Alcimus gave orders to pull down the wall of the inner court of the sanctuary. He also pulled down the works of the prophets.
55 He began to pull down. At that time was Alcimus stricken, and his works were hindered; and his mouth was stopped, and he was taken with a palsy, and he could no more speak anything and give orders concerning his house.
56 Alcimus died at that time with great torment.
57 Bacchides saw that Alcimus was dead, and he returned to the king. Then the land of Judah had rest for two years.

58 Then all the lawless men took counsel, saying, "Behold, Jonathan and his men are dwelling at ease and in security. Now therefore we will bring Bacchides, and he will capture them all in one night.
59 They went and consulted with him.
60 He marched out and came with a great army, and sent letters secretly to all his allies who were in Judea, that they should seize Jonathan and those who were with him; but they couldn't, because their plan was known to them.
61 Jonathan's men seized about fifty of the men of the country who were authors of the wickedness, and he killed them.
62 Jonathan, Simon, and those who were with him, went away to Bethbasi, which is in the wilderness, and he built up that which had been pulled down, and they made it strong.
63 Bacchides found out about it, and he gathered together all his multitude, and sent orders to those who were of Judea.

‡ **9:54** circa B.C. 160.

64 He went and encamped against
Bethbasi and fought against it many days,
and made engines of war.
65 Jonathan left his brother Simon in the
city, and went out into the country, and he
went with a few men.
66 He struck Odomera and his kindred,
and the children of Phasiron in their tents.
67 They began to strike them, and to go
up with their forces. Then Simon and
those who were with him went out of the
city, and set the engines of war on fire,
68 and fought against Bacchides, and he
was defeated by them. They afflicted him
severely; for his counsel and expedition
was in vain.
69 They were very angry with the
lawless men who gave him counsel to
come into the country, and they killed
many of them. Then he decided to depart
into his own land.
70 Jonathan learned of this and sent
ambassadors to him, to the end that they
should make peace with him, and that he
should restore to them the captives.
71 He accepted the thing, and did
according to his words, and swore to him
that he would not seek his harm all the
days of his life.
72 He restored to him the captives which
he had taken before out of the land of
Judah, and he returned and departed into
his own land, and didn't come any more
into their borders.
73 Thus the sword ceased from Israel.
Jonathan lived at Michmash. Jonathan
began to judge the people; and he
destroyed the ungodly out of Israel.

10

1 In the one hundred sixtieth year,†
Alexander Epiphanes, the son of
Antiochus, went up and took possession
of Ptolemais. They received him, and he
reigned there.
2 King Demetrius heard about this, and
he gathered together exceedingly great
forces, and went out to meet him in battle.
3 Demetrius sent a letter to Jonathan
with words of peace, so as to honor him.
4 For he said, "Let's go beforehand to
make peace with them, before he makes
peace with Alexander against us;
5 for he will remember all the evils that
we have done against him, and to his
kindred and to his nation."
6 So he gave him authority to gather
together forces, and to provide weapons,
and that he should be his ally. He also
commanded that they should release the
hostages that were in the citadel to him.

7 Jonathan came to Jerusalem, and read
the letter in the hearing of all the people,
and of those who were in the citadel.
8 They were very afraid when they
heard that the king had given him
authority to gather together an army.
9 Those in the citadel released the
hostages to Jonathan, and he restored
them to their parents.

10 Jonathan lived in Jerusalem and
began to build and renew the city.
11 He commanded those who did the
work to build the walls and encircle
Mount Zion with square stones for
defense; and they did so.
12 The foreigners who were in the
strongholds which Bacchides had built
fled away.
13 Each man left his place and departed
into his own land.
14 Only at Bethsura, there were left
some of those who had forsaken the law
and the commandments, for it was a place
of refuge to them.

15 King Alexander heard all the
promises which Demetrius had sent to
Jonathan. They told him of the battles and
the valiant deeds which he and his
kindred had done, and of the troubles
which they had endured.
16 So he said, "Could we find another
man like him? Now we will make him
our‡ friend and ally."
17 He wrote a letter and sent it to him, in
these words, saying,
18 "King Alexander to his brother
Jonathan, greetings.

† **10:1** circa B.C. 153. ‡ **10:16** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. Compare 1 Maccabees 10:65. § **10:19** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. Compare 1 Maccabees 10:65.

19 We have heard of you, that you are a
mighty man of valour, and worthy to be
our§ friend.
20 Now we have appointed you this day
to be high priest of your nation, and to be
called the king's† friend, and to take our
side, and to keep friendship with us." He
also sent to him a purple robe and a
golden crown.
21 And Jonathan put on the holy
garments in the seventh month of the one
hundred sixtieth year,‡ at the feast of
tabernacles; and he gathered together
forces and provided weapons in
abundance.
22 When Demetrius heard these things,
he was grieved and said,
23 "What is this that we have done, that
Alexander has gotten ahead of us in
establishing friendship with the Jews to
strengthen himself?
24 I also will write to them words of
encouragement and of honor and of gifts,
that they may be with me to aid me."
25 So he sent to them this message:

"King Demetrius to the nation of the
Jews, greetings.
26 Since as you have kept your
covenants with us, and continued in our
friendship, and have not joined
yourselves to our enemies, we have heard
of this, and are glad.
27 Now continue still to keep faith with
us, and we will repay you with good in
return for your dealings with us.
28 We will grant you many immunities
and give you gifts.
29 "Now I free you and release all the
Jews from the tributes, from the salt tax,
and from the crown levies.
30 Instead of the third part of the seed,
and instead of half of the fruit of the trees,
which falls to me to receive, I release it
from this day and henceforth, so that I
will not take it from the land of Judah, and
from the three districts which are added
to it from the country of Samaria and
Galilee, from this day forth and for all
time.
31 Let Jerusalem be holy and free, with
her borders, tithes, and taxes.
32 I yield up also my authority over the
citadel which is at Jerusalem, and give it
to the high priest, that he may appoint in
it men whom he chooses to keep it.
33 Every soul of the Jews who has been
carried captive from the land of Judah
into any part of my kingdom, I set at
liberty without payment. Let all officials
also cancel the taxes on their livestock.
34 "All the feasts, the Sabbaths, new
moons, appointed days, three days before
a feast, and three days after a feast, let
them all be days of immunity and release
for all the Jews who are in my kingdom.
35 No man shall have authority to exact
anything from any of them, or to trouble
them concerning any matter.
36 "Let there be enrolled among the
king's forces about thirty thousand men
of the Jews, and pay shall be given to
them, as is due to all the king's forces.
37 Of them, some shall be placed in the
king's great strongholds, and some of
them shall be placed over the affairs of
the kingdom, which are positions of trust.
Let those who are over them and their
rulers be of themselves, and let them walk
after their own laws, even as the king has
commanded in the land of Judah.
38 "The three districts that have been
added to Judea from the country of
Samaria, let them be annexed to Judea,
that they may be reckoned to be under
one ruler, that they may not obey any
other authority than the high priest's.
39 As for Ptolemais and its land, I have
given it as a gift to the sanctuary that is at
Jerusalem, for the expenses of the
sanctuary.
40 I also give every year fifteen thousand
shekels of silver from the king's revenues
from the places that are appropriate.
41 And all the additional funds which
those who manage the king's affairs didn't
pay as in the first years, they shall give
from now on toward the works of the
temple.

† **10:20** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. Compare 1 Maccabees 10:65. ‡ **10:21** circa B.C. 153.

42 Besides this, the five thousand shekels
of silver which they received from the
uses of the sanctuary from the revenue
year by year is also released, because it
belongs to the priests who minister there.
43 Whoever flees to the temple that is at
Jerusalem, and within all of its borders,
whether owing money to the king, or any
other matter, let them go free, along with
all that they have in my kingdom.
44 For the building and renewing of the
structures of the sanctuary, the expense
shall also be given out of the king's
revenue.
45 For the building of the walls of
Jerusalem and fortifying it all around, the
expense shall also be given out of the
king's revenue, also for the building of the
walls in Judea."
46 Now when Jonathan and the people
heard these words, they gave no credence
to them, and didn't accept them, because
they remembered the great evil which he
had done in Israel, and that he had
afflicted them very severely.
47 They were well pleased with
Alexander, because he was the first who
spoke words of peace to them, and they
were allies with him always.
48 King Alexander gathered together
great forces and encamped near
Demetrius.
49 The two kings joined battle, and the
army of Alexander fled; and Demetrius
followed after him, and prevailed against
them.
50 He strengthened the battle
exceedingly until the sun went down; and
Demetrius fell that day.
51 Alexander sent ambassadors to
Ptolemy king of Egypt with this message:
52 "Since I have returned to my
kingdom, and am seated on the throne of
my fathers, and have established my
dominion, and have overthrown
Demetrius, and have taken possession of
our country—
53 yes, I joined the battle with him, and
he and his army were defeated by us, and
we sat on the throne of his kingdom—
54 now also let's make friends with one
another. Give me now your daughter as
my wife. I will be joined with you, and will
give both you and her gifts worthy of you."
55 Ptolemy the king answered, saying,
"Happy is the day you returned to the land
of your ancestors and sat on the throne of
their kingdom.
56 Now I will do to you as you have
written, but meet me at Ptolemais, that we
may see one another; and I will join with
you, even as you have said."
57 So Ptolemy went out of Egypt, himself
and Cleopatra his daughter, and came to
Ptolemais in the one hundred
sixty-second year.§
58 King Alexander met him, and he gave
him his daughter Cleopatra, and
celebrated her wedding at Ptolemais with
great pomp, as kings do.
59 King Alexander wrote to Jonathan,
that he should come to meet him.
60 He went with pomp to Ptolemais, and
met the two kings. He gave them and their
friends† silver and gold, and many gifts,
and found favor in their sight.
61 Some malcontents out of Israel, men
who were transgressors of the law,
gathered together against him to
complain against him; but the king paid
no attention to them.
62 The king commanded that they take
off Jonathan's garments and clothe him in
purple, and they did so.
63 The king made him sit with him, and
said to his princes, "Go out with him into
the midst of the city, and proclaim that no
man may complain against him of any
matter, and let no man trouble him for
any reason."
64 It came to pass, when those who
complained against him saw his honor
according to the proclamation, and saw
him clothed in purple, they all fled away.
65 The king gave him honor, and
enrolled him among his chief friends,‡
and made him a captain and governor of
a province.

§ **10:57** circa B.C. 151. † **10:60** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. Compare 1 Maccabees 10:65. ‡ **10:65** See 1 Maccabees 11:27; 2 Maccabees 8:9. Compare 1 Maccabees 2:18; 10:16, etc.

66 Then Jonathan returned to Jerusalem
with peace and gladness.

67 In the one hundred sixty-fifth year,§
Demetrius, son of Demetrius, came out of
Crete into the land of his ancestors.
68 When King Alexander heard of it, he
grieved exceedingly and returned to
Antioch.
69 Demetrius appointed Apollonius,
who was over Coelesyria, and he gathered
together a great army, and encamped
against Jamnia, and sent to Jonathan the
high priest, saying,

70 "You alone lift up yourself against us,
but I am ridiculed and in reproach
because of you. Why do you assume
authority against us in the mountains?
71 Now therefore, if you trust in your
forces, come down to us into the plain,
and let's match strength with each other
there; for the power of the cities is with
me.
72 Ask and learn who I am, and the rest
who help us. They say, 'Your foot can't
stand before our face; for your ancestors
have been put to flight twice in their own
land.'
73 Now you won't be able to withstand
the cavalry and such an army as this in
the plain, where there is no stone or
pebble, or place to flee."

74 Now when Jonathan heard the words
of Apollonius, he was moved in his mind,
and he chose ten thousand men, and went
out from Jerusalem; and Simon his
brother met him to help him.
75 Then he encamped against Joppa. The
people of the city shut him out, because
Apollonius had a garrison in Joppa.
76 So they fought against it. The people
of the city were afraid, and opened to him;
and Jonathan became master of Joppa.

77 Apollonius heard about that, and he
gathered an army of three thousand
cavalry, and a great army, and went to
Azotus as though he were on a journey,
and at the same time advanced onward
into the plain, because he had a multitude
of cavalry which he trusted.

78 He pursued him to Azotus, and the
armies joined battle.†
79 Apollonius had secretly left a
thousand cavalry behind them.
80 Jonathan learned that there was an
ambush behind him. They surrounded
his army, and shot their arrows at the
people, from morning until evening;
81 but the people stood fast, as Jonathan
commanded them; and the enemy's
horses grew tired.
82 Then Simon brought forward his
army and joined battle with the phalanx
(for the cavalry were exhausted), and
they were defeated by him and fled.
83 The cavalry were scattered in the
plain. They fled to Azotus and entered
into Beth-dagon, their idol's temple, to
save themselves.
84 Jonathan burned Azotus and the
cities around it and took their spoils. He
burned the temple of Dagon and those
who fled into it with fire.
85 Those who had fallen by the sword
plus those who were burned were about
eight thousand men.
86 From there, Jonathan left and
encamped against Ascalon. The people of
the city came out to meet him with great
pomp.
87 Jonathan, with those who were on his
side, returned to Jerusalem, having many
spoils.
88 It came to pass, when King Alexander
heard these things, he honored Jonathan
even more.
89 He sent him a gold buckle, as the
custom is to give to the king's kindred. He
gave him Ekron and all its land for a
possession.

11

1 Then the king of Egypt gathered
together great forces, as the sand which is
by the sea shore, and many ships, and
sought to make himself master of
Alexander's kingdom by deceit, and to
add it to his own kingdom.
2 He went out into Syria with words of
peace, and the people of the cities opened

§ **10:67** circa B.C. 148. † **10:78** Most of the authorities here repeat *after him.*

their gates to him and met him; for King Alexander's command was that they should meet him, because he was his father-in-law.
3 Now as he entered into the cities of Ptolemais, he set his forces for a garrison in each city.

4 But when he came near to Azotus, they showed him the temple of Dagon burned with fire, and Azotus and its pasture lands destroyed, and the bodies cast out, and those who had been burned, whom he burned in the war, for they had made heaps of them in his way.
5 They told the king what Jonathan had done, that they might cast blame on him; but the king kept silent.
6 Jonathan met the king with pomp at Joppa, and they greeted one another, and they slept there.
7 Jonathan went with the king as far as the river that is called Eleutherus, then returned to Jerusalem.

8 But King Ptolemy took control of the cities along the sea coast, to Selucia which is by the sea, and he devised evil plans concerning Alexander.
9 He sent ambassadors to King Demetrius, saying, "Come! Let's make a covenant with one another, and I will give you my daughter whom Alexander has, and you shall reign over your father's kingdom;
10 for I regret that I gave my daughter to him, for he tried to kill me.
11 He accused him, because he coveted his kingdom.
12 Taking his daughter from him, he gave her to Demetrius, and was estranged from Alexander, and their enmity was openly seen.

13 Ptolemy entered into Antioch, and put on himself the crown of Asia. He put two crowns upon his head, the crown of Egypt and that of Asia.
14 But King Alexander was in Cilicia at that time, because the people of that region were in revolt.
15 When Alexander heard of it, he came against him in war. Ptolemy marched out and met him with a strong force, and put him to flight.
16 Alexander fled into Arabia, that he might be sheltered there; but King Ptolemy was triumphant.
17 Zabdiel the Arabian took off Alexander's head, and sent it to Ptolemy.
18 King Ptolemy died the third day after, and those who were in his strongholds were slain by the inhabitants of the strongholds.
19 Demetrius became king in the one hundred sixty-seventh year.†

20 In those days Jonathan gathered together the Judeans to take the citadel that was at Jerusalem. He made many engines of war to use against it.
21 Some lawless men who hated their own nation went to the king and reported to him that Jonathan was besieging the citadel.
22 He heard, and was angry, but when he heard it, he set out immediately, and came to Ptolemais, and wrote to Jonathan, that he should not besiege it, and that he should meet him and speak with him at Ptolemais with all speed.

23 But when Jonathan heard this, he gave orders to continue the siege. He chose some of the elders of Israel and of the priests, and put himself in peril
24 by taking silver, gold, clothing, and various other presents, and went to Ptolemais to the king. Then he found favor in his sight.
25 Some lawless men of those who were of the nation made complaints against him,
26 and the king did to him even as his predecessors had done to him, and exalted him in the sight of all his‡ friends,
27 and confirmed to him the high priesthood, and all the other honors that he had before, and gave him preeminence among his§ chief friends.
28 And Jonathan requested of the king that he would make Judea free from

† **11:19** circa B.C. 146. ‡ **11:26** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. § **11:27** See 1 Maccabees 10:65. † **11:28** Gr. *toparchies*

tribute, along with the three† provinces
and the country of Samaria, and promised
him three hundred talents.
29 The king consented, and wrote letters
to Jonathan concerning all these things as
follows:
30 "King Demetrius to his brother
Jonathan, and to the nation of the Jews,
greetings.
31 The copy of the letter which we wrote
to Lasthenes our kinsman concerning
you, we have written also to you, that you
may see it.
32 'King Demetrius to Lasthenes his
father, greetings.
33 We have determined to do good to the
nation of the Jews, who are our friends,
and observe what is just toward us,
because of their good will toward us.
34 We have confirmed therefore to them
the borders of Judea, and also the three
governments of Aphaerema, Lydda, and
Ramathaim (these were added to Judea
from the country of Samaria), and all
their territory to them, for all who do
sacrifice in Jerusalem, instead of the
king's dues which the king received of
them yearly before from the produce of
the earth and the fruits of trees.
35 As for the other payments to us from
henceforth, of the tithes and the taxes that
pertain to us, and the salt pits, and the
crown taxes due to us, all these we will
give back to them.
36 Not one of these grants shall be
annulled from this time forth and forever.
37 Now therefore be careful to make a
copy of these things, and let it be given to
Jonathan, and let it be set up on the holy
mountain in a suitable and conspicuous
place.' "
38 When King Demetrius saw that the
land was quiet before him, and that no
resistance was made to him, he sent away
all his troops, each man to his own place,
except the foreign troops, which he had
raised from the islands of the Gentiles. So
all the troops of his fathers hated him.
39 Now Tryphon was one of those who
previously had been on Alexander's side,
and he saw that all the forces murmured
against Demetrius. So he went to Imalcue
the Arabian, who was raising up
Antiochus the young child of Alexander,
40 and urgently insisted to him that he
should deliver him to him, that he might
reign in his father's place. He told him all
that Demetrius had done, and the hatred
with which his forces hated him; and he
stayed there many days.
41 Now Jonathan sent to King
Demetrius, that he should remove the
troops of the citadel from Jerusalem, and
the troops who were in the strongholds;
for they fought against Israel continually.
42 Demetrius sent to Jonathan, saying, "I
will not only do this for you and your
nation, but I will greatly honor you and
your nation, if I find an opportunity.
43 Now therefore you shall do well if you
send me men who will fight for me; for all
my forces have revolted."
44 So Jonathan sent him three thousand
valiant men to Antioch. They came to the
king, and the king was glad at their
coming.
45 The people of the city gathered
themselves together into the midst of the
city, to the number of one hundred and
twenty thousand men, and they wanted to
kill the king.
46 The king fled into the court of the
palace, and the people of the city seized
the main streets of the city and began to
fight.
47 The king called the Jews to help him,
and they were gathered together to him
all at once, and they dispersed themselves
in the city, and killed that day about one
hundred thousand.
48 They set the city on fire, and seized
many spoils that day, and saved the king.
49 The people of the city saw that the
Jews had taken control of the city as they
pleased, and they became faint in their
hearts, and they cried out to the king with
supplication, saying,
50 "Give us your right hand, and let the
Jews cease from fighting against us and
the city."
51 They threw away their weapons and
made peace. The Jews were glorified in

the sight of the king, and before all who were in his kingdom. Then they returned to Jerusalem, having much plunder.
52 So King Demetrius sat on the throne of his kingdom, and the land was quiet before him.
53 He lied in all that he spoke, and estranged himself from Jonathan, and didn't repay him according to the benefits with which he had repaid him, and treated him very harshly.

54 Now after this, Tryphon returned, and with him the young child Antiochus, who reigned and put on a crown.
55 All the forces which Demetrius had sent away with disgrace were gathered to him, and they fought against him, and he fled and was routed.
56 Tryphon took the elephants, and took control of Antioch.
57 The young Antiochus wrote to Jonathan, saying, "I confirm to you the high priesthood, and appoint you over the four districts, and to be one of the king's‡ friends."
58 He sent to him golden vessels and furniture for the table, and gave him permission to drink in golden vessels, and to be clothed in purple, and to have a golden buckle.
59 He made his brother Simon governor from the Ladder of Tyre to the borders of Egypt.

60 Jonathan went out and took his journey beyond the river and through the cities. All the forces of Syria gathered themselves to him to be his allies. He came to Ascalon, and the people of the city met him honorably.
61 He departed from there to Gaza, and the people of Gaza shut him out. So he besieged it and burned its pasture lands with fire, and plundered them.
62 The people of Gaza pleaded with Jonathan, and he gave them his right hand, and took the sons of their princes for hostages, and sent them away to Jerusalem. Then he passed through the country as far as Damascus.
63 Then Jonathan heard that Demetrius' princes had come to Kedesh, which is in Galilee, with a great army, intending to remove him from his office.
64 He went to meet them, but he left Simon his brother in the country.
65 Simon encamped against Bethsura, and fought against it many days, and hemmed it in.
66 They asked him to give them his right hand, and he gave it to them. He removed them from there, took possession of the city, and set a garrison over it.
67 Jonathan and his army encamped at the water of Gennesareth, and early in the morning they marched to the plain of Hazor.
68 Behold, an army of foreigners met him in the plain. They laid an ambush for him in the mountains, but they themselves met him face to face.
69 But those who lay in ambush rose out of their places and joined battle. All those who were on Jonathan's side fled.
70 Not one of them was left, except Mattathias the son of Absalom, and Judas the son of Chalphi, captains of the forces.
71 Jonathan tore his clothes, put dirt on his head, and prayed.
72 He turned again to them in battle, and routed them, and they fled.
73 When the men on his side who had fled saw this, they returned to him and pursued with him to Kedesh to their camp, and they encamped there.
74 About three thousand men of the foreigners fell on that day. Then Jonathan returned to Jerusalem.

12

1 Jonathan saw that the time was favorable for him, so he chose men and sent them to Rome to confirm and renew the friendship that they had with them.
2 He also sent similar letters to the Spartans, and to other places.
3 They went to Rome, entered into the senate house, and said, "Jonathan the high priest and the nation of the Jews have sent us to renew for them the friendship and the alliance, as in former time."

‡ **11:57** See 1 Maccabees 2:18.

4 They gave them letters to the men in
every place, that they should provide safe
conduct for them on their way to the land
of Judah.
5 This is the copy of the letters which
Jonathan wrote to the Spartans:
6 "Jonathan the high priest, and the
senate of the nation, and the priests, and
the rest of the people of the Jews, to their
kindred the Spartans, greetings.
7 Even before this time letters were sent
to Onias the high priest from Arius,† who
was reigning among you, to signify that
you are our kindred, as the copy written
below shows.
8 Onias welcomed honorably the man
who was sent and received the letters,
wherein declaration was made of alliance
and friendship.
9 Therefore we also, even though we
need none of these things, having for our
encouragement the holy books which are
in our hands,
10 have undertaken to send that we
might renew our brotherhood and
friendship with you, to the end that we
should not become estranged from you
altogether; for a long time has passed
since you sent your letter to us.
11 We therefore at all times without
ceasing, both in our feasts, and on the
other convenient days, remember you in
the sacrifices which we offer, and in our
prayers, as it is right and proper to be
mindful of kindred.
12 Moreover, we are glad for your glory.
13 But as for ourselves, many afflictions
and many wars have encompassed us,
and the kings who are around us have
fought against us.
14 We were unwilling to be troublesome
to you, and to the rest of our allies and
friends, in these wars;
15 for we have the help which is from
heaven to help us, and we have been
delivered from our enemies, and our
enemies have been humbled.
16 We chose therefore Numenius the son
of Antiochus and Antipater the son of
Jason, and have sent them to the Romans,
to renew the friendship that we had with
them, and the former alliance.
17 We commanded them therefore to go
also to you, and to salute you, and to
deliver you our letters concerning the
renewing of friendship and our
brotherhood.
18 And now you will do well if you give
us a reply."

19 And this is the copy of the letters
which they sent to Onias:

20 "Arius king of the Spartans to Onias
the chief priest, greetings.
21 It has been found in writing,
concerning the Spartans and the Jews,
that they are kindred, and that they are of
the descendants of Abraham.
22 Now, since this has come to our
knowledge, you will do well to write to us
of your‡ prosperity.
23 We moreover write on our part to
you, that your livestock and goods are
ours, and ours are yours. We do
command therefore that they make
report to you accordingly."

24 Now Jonathan heard that Demetrius'
princes had returned to fight against him
with a greater army than before,
25 so he marched away from Jerusalem,
and met them in the country of Hamath;
for he gave them no opportunity to set
foot in his country.
26 He sent spies into his camp, and they
came again, and reported to him that they
were preparing to attack them at night.
27 But as soon as the sun was down,
Jonathan commanded his men to watch,
and to be armed, that all the night long
they might be ready for battle. He
stationed sentinels around the camp.
28 The adversaries heard that Jonathan
and his men were ready for battle, and
they feared, and trembled in their hearts,
and they kindled fires in their camp then
withdrew.
29 But Jonathan and his men didn't
know it until the morning; for they saw
the fires burning.

† **12:7** So the old Latin versions and Josephus: compare also ver. 20. All the other authorities read *Darius* in this place. ‡ **12:22** Gr. *peace*

30 Jonathan pursued after them, but
didn't overtake them; for they had gone
over the river Eleutherus.
31 Then Jonathan turned toward the
Arabians, who are called Zabadaeans, and
struck them, and took their spoils.
32 He came out from there, and came to
Damascus, and took his journey through
all the country.
33 Simon went out, and took his journey
as far as Ascalon, and the strongholds that
were near it. Then he turned toward
Joppa and took possession of it;
34 for he had heard that they were
planning to hand over the stronghold to
Demetrius' men. He set a garrison there to
guard it.
35 Then Jonathan returned and called
the elders of the people together. He
planned with them to build strongholds in
Judea,
36 and to make the walls of Jerusalem
higher, and to raise a great mound
between the citadel and the city, to
separate it from the city, that so it might
be isolated, that its garrison might neither
buy nor sell.
37 They were gathered together to build
the city. Part of the wall of the brook that
is on the east side had fallen down, and he
repaired the section called Chaphenatha.
38 Simon also built Adida in the§ plain
country, made it strong, and set up gates
and bars.
39 And Tryphon sought to reign over
Asia and to crown himself, and to stretch
out his hand against Antiochus the king.
40 He was afraid that Jonathan wouldn't
allow him, and that he would fight against
him; and he sought a way to seize him,
that he might destroy him. So he marched
out and came to Bethshan.
41 Jonathan came out to meet him with
forty thousand men chosen for battle, and
came to Bethshan.
42 Tryphon saw that he came with a
great army, and he was afraid to stretch
out his hand against him.
43 He received him honorably, and
commended him to all his† friends, and
gave him gifts, and commanded his forces
to be obedient to him, as to himself.
44 He said to Jonathan, "Why have you
put all these people to so much trouble,
seeing there is no war between us?
45 Now send them away to their homes,
but choose for yourself a few men who
shall be with you, and come with me to
Ptolemais, and I will give it to you, and the
rest of the strongholds and the rest of the
forces, and all the king's officers. Then I
will turn around and depart; for this is
why I came."
46 He put his trust in him, and did even
as he said, and sent away his forces, and
they departed into the land of Judah.
47 But he reserved to himself three
thousand men, of whom he left two
thousand in Galilee, but one thousand
went with him.
48 Now as soon as Jonathan entered into
Ptolemais, the people of Ptolemais shut
the gates and seized him. They killed all
those who came in with him with the
sword.
49 Tryphon sent troops and cavalry into
Galilee, and into the Great Plain, to
destroy all Jonathan's men.
50 They perceived that he had been
seized and had perished, along with those
who were with him. They encouraged one
another and went on their way close
together, prepared to fight.
51 Those who followed them saw that
they were ready to fight for their lives,
and turned back again.
52 They all came in peace into the land
of Judah, and they mourned for Jonathan
and those who were with him, and they
were very afraid. All Israel mourned with
a great mourning.
53 And all the Gentiles who were around
them sought to destroy them utterly; for
they said, "They have no ruler nor anyone
to help them. Now therefore let's fight
against them, and take away their
memory from among men."

13

1 Simon heard that Tryphon had

§ **12:38** Gr. *Sephela.* † **12:43** See 1 Maccabees 2:18.

gathered together a mighty army to come into the land of Judah and destroy it utterly.
2 He saw that the people were trembling in great fear. So he went up to Jerusalem and gathered the people together.
3 He encouraged them, and said to them, “You yourselves know all the things that I, my kindred, and my father’s house have done for the laws and the sanctuary, and the battles and the distresses which we have seen.
4 Because of this, all my brothers have perished for Israel’s sake, and I am left alone.
5 Now be it far from me, that I should spare my own life in any time of affliction, for I am not better than my kindred.
6 However, I will take vengeance for my nation, for the sanctuary, and for our wives and children, because all the Gentiles have gathered out of hatred to destroy us.”
7 The spirit of the people revived as soon as they heard these words.
8 They answered with a loud voice, saying, “You are our leader in the place of Judas and Jonathan your brothers.
9 Fight our battles, and we will do all that you tell us to do.”
10 He gathered together all the men of war, and hurried to finish the walls of Jerusalem. He fortified it all around.
11 He sent Jonathan the son of Absalom, and with him a great army, to Joppa. He threw out those who were in it, and lived there.
12 Tryphon left Ptolemais with a mighty army to enter into the land of Judah, and Jonathan was with him under guard.
13 But Simon encamped at Adida, near the plain.
14 Tryphon knew that Simon had risen up in the place of his brother Jonathan, and meant to join battle with him, so he sent ambassadors to him, saying,
15 “It is for money which Jonathan your brother owed to the king’s treasury, by reason of the offices which he had, that we are detaining him.
16 Now send one hundred talents of silver and two of his sons for hostages, so that when he is released he may not revolt against us, and we will release him.”
17 Simon knew that they spoke to him deceitfully, but he sent to get the money and the children, lest perhaps he would arouse great hostility among the people,
18 who might say, “Because I didn’t send him the money and the children, he perished.”
19 So he sent the children and the hundred talents, but Tryphon lied, and didn’t release Jonathan.
20 After this, Tryphon came to invade the land and destroy it, and he went around by the way that leads to Adora. Simon and his army marched near him to every place, wherever he went.
21 Now the people of the citadel sent to Tryphon ambassadors, urging him to come to them through the wilderness, and to send them food.
22 So Tryphon prepared all his cavalry to come, but on that night a very heavy snow fell, and he didn’t come because of the snow. He marched off and went into the land of Gilead.
23 When he came near to Bascama, he killed Jonathan, and he was buried there.
24 Then Tryphon turned back, and went away into his own land.
25 Simon sent, and took the bones of Jonathan his brother, and buried him at Modin, the city of his fathers.
26 All Israel made great lamentation over him, and mourned for him many days.
27 Simon built a monument on the tomb of his father and his kindred, and raised it high so that it could be seen, with polished stone on the front and back.
28 He also set up seven pyramids, one near another, for his father, his mother, and his four brothers.
29 For these, he made an elaborate setting, erecting great pillars around them, and upon the pillars he made suits of armor for a perpetual memorial, and beside the suits of armor, he carved ships, so that they could be seen by all who sail on the sea.

30 This is the tomb which he made at
Modin. It remains to this day.
31 Now Tryphon deceived the young
King Antiochus and killed him,
32 and reigned in his place. He put on
himself the crown of Asia and brought a
great calamity upon the land.
33 Simon built up the strongholds of
Judea, and walled them all around with
high towers, great walls, gates, and bars;
and he stored food in the strongholds.
34 Simon chose men, and sent to King
Demetrius with a request that he grant
the country an immunity, because all that
Tryphon did was to plunder.
35 King Demetrius sent to him according
to these words, and answered him, and
wrote a letter to him, as follows:
36 "King Demetrius to Simon the high
priest and friend† of kings, and to the
elders and nation of the Jews, greetings.
37 The golden crown and the palm
branch, which you sent, we have
received. We are ready to make a
steadfast peace with you, yes, and to write
to our officers to release you from tribute.
38 Whatever things we confirmed to
you, they are confirmed. The strongholds,
which you have built, let them be your
own.
39 As for any oversights and faults
committed to this day, we forgive them,
and the crown tax which you owed us. If
there were any other tax collected in
Jerusalem, let it be collected no longer.
40 If any among you are qualified to be
enrolled in our court, let them be enrolled,
and let there be peace between us."
41 In the one hundred seventieth year,‡
the yoke of the Gentiles was taken away
from Israel.
42 The people began to write in their
instruments and contracts, "In the first
year of Simon, the great high priest and
captain and leader of the Jews."
43 In those days Simon encamped
against§ Gazara, and surrounded it with
troops. He made a siege engine, and
brought it up to the city, and struck a
tower, and captured it.
44 Those who were in the engine leaped
out into the city; and there was a great
uproar in the city.
45 The people of the city tore their
clothes, and went up on the walls with
their wives and children, and cried with a
loud voice, asking Simon to give them† his
right hand.
46 They said, "Don't deal with us
according to our wickednesses, but
according to your mercy."
47 So Simon was reconciled to them, and
didn't fight against them; but he expelled
them from the city and cleansed the
houses where the idols were, and then
entered into it with singing and giving
praise.
48 He removed all uncleanness out of it,
and placed in it men who would keep the
law, and made it stronger than it was
before, and built a dwelling place for
himself in it.
49 But the people of the citadel in
Jerusalem were hindered from going out
and from going into the country, and from
buying and selling. So they were very
hungry, and a great number of them
perished from famine.
50 Then they cried out to Simon, that he
should give them his right hand; and he
gave it to them; but he expelled them from
there, and he cleansed the citadel from its
pollutions.
51 He entered into it on the twenty-third
day of the second month, in the one
hundred seventy-first year,‡ with praise
and palm branches, with harps, with
cymbals, and with stringed instruments,
with hymns, and with songs, because a
great enemy had been destroyed out of
Israel.
52 Simon ordained that they should keep
that day every year with gladness. He
made the hill of the temple that was by the
citadel stronger than before, and he lived
there with his men.

† **13:36** See 1 Maccabees 2:18. ‡ **13:41** circa B.C. 143. § **13:43** See 1 Maccabees 13:53 (compare 1 Maccabees 13:48); 1 Maccabees 14:7, 34; 15:28; 16:1: also Josephus. All the authorities read *Gaza* in this verse. † **13:45** Gr. *right hands.* ‡ **13:51** circa B.C. 142.

53 Simon saw that his son John was a
man, so he made him leader of all his
forces; and he lived in Gazara.

14

1 In the one hundred seventy-second
year,† King Demetrius gathered his forces
together, and went into Media to get help,
that he might fight against Tryphon.
2 When Arsaces, the king of Persia and
Media, heard that Demetrius had come
into his borders, he sent one of his princes
to take him alive.
3 He went and struck the army of
Demetrius, and seized him and brought
him to Arsaces, who put him under guard.
4 The land had rest all the days of
Simon. He sought the good of his nation.
His authority and his honor was pleasing
to them all his days.
5 Amid all his honors, he took Joppa for
a harbor, and made it an entrance for the
islands of the sea.
6 He enlarged the borders of his nation
and took possession of the country.
7 He gathered together a great number
of captives, and took control of Gazara,
Bethsura, and the citadel, and he removed
its uncleannesses from it. There was no
one who resisted him.
8 They tilled their land in peace, and the
land gave her increase, and the trees of
the plains gave their fruit.
9 The old men sat in the streets; they all
conversed together about good things.
The young men put on glorious and
warlike apparel.
10 He provided food for the cities and
furnished them with means of defense,
until the glory of his name was known to
the end of the earth.
11 He made peace in the land, and Israel
rejoiced with great joy.
12 Each man sat under his vine and his
fig tree, and there was no one to make
them afraid.
13 No one was left in the land who
fought against them. The kings were
defeated in those days.
14 He strengthened all those of his
people who were humble. He searched
out the law, and every lawless and wicked
person he took away.
15 He glorified the sanctuary, and added
to the vessels of the temple.
16 It was heard at Rome that Jonathan
was dead, and even in Sparta, and they
were exceedingly grieved.
17 But as soon as they heard that his
brother Simon was made high priest in
his place, and ruled the country and the
cities in it,
18 they wrote to him on brass tablets to
renew with him the friendship and the
alliance which they had confirmed with
his brothers Judas and Jonathan.
19 These were read before the
congregation at Jerusalem.
20 This is the copy of the letter which the
Spartans sent:
"The rulers and the city of the Spartans,
to Simon the high priest, to the elders, the
priests, and the rest of the people of the
Jews, our kindred, greetings.
21 The ambassadors who were sent to
our people reported to us about your
glory and honor. We were glad for their
coming,
22 and we registered the things that
were spoken by them in the public
records‡ as follows: 'Numenius son of
Antiochus, and Antipater son of Jason, the
Jews' ambassadors, came to us to renew
the friendship they had with us.
23 It pleased the people to entertain the
men honorably, and to put the copy of
their words in the public records,§ to the
end that the people of the Spartans might
have a record of them. Moreover they
wrote a copy of these things to Simon the
high priest.' "
24 After this, Simon sent Numenius to
Rome with a great shield of gold weighing
one thousand minas,† in order to confirm
the alliance with them.
25 But when the people heard these
things, they said, "What thanks shall we
give to Simon and his sons?

† **14:1** circa B.C. 141. ‡ **14:22** Gr. *counsels of the people.* § **14:23** Gr. *books that are appointed for the people.*
† **14:24** 1,000 minas is about 499 kg or 1,098 pounds.

26 For he and his brothers and the house
of his father have made themselves
strong, and have fought and chased away
Israel's enemies, and confirmed liberty to
Israel.‡"
27 So they wrote on tablets of brass, and
set them on pillars on mount Zion. This is
the copy of the writing:
"On the eighteenth day of Elul, in the
one hundred seventy-second year,§ which
is the third year of Simon the high priest,
28 in Asaramel, in a great congregation
of priests and people and princes of the
nation, and of the elders of the country, it
was proclaimed to us:†
29 'Since wars often occurred in the
country, Simon the son of Mattathias, the
son of the sons of Joarib, and his brothers,
put themselves in jeopardy and withstood
the enemies of their nation, that their
sanctuary and the law might be
established, and glorified their nation
with great glory.
30 Jonathan rallied the nation, became
their high priest, and was gathered to his
people.
31 Their enemies planned to invade
their country, that they might destroy
their country utterly, and stretch out their
hands against their sanctuary.
32 Then Simon rose up and fought for
his nation. He spent much of his own
money to arm the valiant men of his
nation and give them wages.
33 He fortified the cities of Judea and
Bethsura that lies on the borders of Judea,
where the weapons of the enemies had
been stored, and there he placed a
garrison of Jews.
34 He fortified Joppa which is upon the
sea, and Gazara which is upon the borders
of Azotus, where the enemies used to live,
and placed Jews there, and set in there all
things necessary for their restoration.
35 The people saw Simon's faith,‡ and
the glory which he resolved to bring to his
nation, and they made him their leader
and high priest, because he had done all
these things, and for the justice and the
faith which he kept to his nation, and
because he sought by all means to exalt
his people.
36 In his days, things prospered in his
hands, so that the Gentiles were taken
away out of their country, and they also
who were in the city of David, those who
were in Jerusalem, who had made
themselves a citadel, out of which they
used to go, and polluted everything
around the sanctuary, and did great
damage to its purity.
37 He placed Jews in it and fortified it for
the safety of the country and the city, and
made high the walls of Jerusalem.
38 King Demetrius confirmed to him the
high priesthood according to these things,
39 and made him one of his friends,§
and honored him with great honor;
40 for he had heard that the Jews had
been called by the Romans friends, allies,
and kindred, and that they had met the
ambassadors of Simon honorably;
41 and that the Jews and the priests were
well pleased that Simon should be their
leader and high priest forever, until there
should arise a faithful prophet;
42 and that he should be governor over
them, and should take charge of the
sanctuary, to set them over their works,
and over the country, and over the
weapons, and over the strongholds; and
that he should take charge of the
sanctuary,
43 and that he should be obeyed by all,
and that all contracts in the country
should be written in his name, and that he
should be clothed in purple, and wear
gold;
44 and that it should not be lawful for
any of the people or of the priests to
nullify any of these things, or to oppose
the words that he should speak, or to
gather an assembly in the country
without him, or to be clothed in purple, or
wear a buckle of gold;
45 but whoever should do otherwise, or
nullify any of these things, he will be
liable to punishment.' "

‡ **14:26** Gr. *him.* § **14:27** circa B.C. 141. † **14:28** Gr. *he made known.* ‡ **14:35** Some authorities read *acts.*
§ **14:39** See 1 Maccabees 2:18.

46 All the people consented to ordain for
Simon that he should do according to
these words.
47 So Simon accepted this, and
consented to be high priest, and to be
captain and governor† of the Jews and of
the priests, and to be protector of all.
48 They commanded to put this writing
on tablets of brass, and to set them up
within the precinct of the sanctuary in a
conspicuous place,
49 and moreover to put copies of them in
the treasury, so that Simon and his sons
might have them.

15

1 Antiochus son of Demetrius the king
sent a letter from the islands of the sea to
Simon the priest and† governor of the
Jews, and to all the nation.
2 Its contents follow:
"King Antiochus to Simon the chief
priest and‡ governor, and to the nation of
the Jews, greetings.
3 Whereas certain troublemakers have
made themselves masters of the kingdom
of our fathers, but my purpose is to claim
the kingdom, that I may restore it as it was
before; and moreover I have raised a
multitude of foreign soldiers, and have
prepared warships;
4 moreover I plan to land in the country,
that I may punish those who have
destroyed our country, and those who
have made many cities in the kingdom
desolate;
5 now therefore I confirm to you all the
tax remissions which the kings who were
before me remitted to you, and whatever
gifts besides they remitted to you,
6 and I permit you to coin money for
your country with your own stamp,
7 but that Jerusalem and the sanctuary
should be free. All the weapons that you
have prepared, and the strongholds that
you have built, which you have in your
possession, let them remain yours.
8 Every debt owed to the king, and the
things that will be owed to the king from
henceforth and for evermore, let them be
remitted to you.
9 Moreover, when we have established
our kingdom, we will glorify you and your
nation and the temple with great glory, so
that your glory will be made manifest in
all the earth.
10 In the one hundred seventy-fourth
year,§ Antiochus went into the land of his
fathers; and all the forces came together
to him, so that there were few men with
Tryphon.
11 King Antiochus pursued him, and he
came, as he fled, to Dor, which is by the
sea;
12 for he knew that troubles had come
upon him all at once, and that his forces
had deserted him.
13 Antiochus encamped against Dor, and
with him one hundred twenty thousand
men of war and eight thousand cavalry.
14 He surrounded the city, and the ships
joined in the attack from the sea. He
harassed the city by land and sea, and
permitted no one to go out or in.
15 Numenius and his company came
from Rome, having letters to the kings
and to the countries, in which were
written these things:
16 "Lucius, consul of the Romans, to
King Ptolemy, greetings.
17 The Jews' ambassadors came to us as
our friends and allies, to renew the old
friendship and alliance, being sent from
Simon the high priest, and from the
people of the Jews.
18 Moreover they brought a shield of
gold weighing one thousand minas.†
19 It pleased us therefore to write to the
kings and to the countries, that they
should not seek their harm or fight against
them, their cities, and their country, or be
allies with those who fight against them.
20 Moreover, it seemed good to us to
receive the shield from them.
21 If therefore any troublemakers have
fled from their country to you, deliver
them to Simon the high priest, that he may

† **14:47** Gr. *ethnarch.* † **15:1** Gr. *ethnarch.* ‡ **15:2** Gr. *ethnarch.* § **15:10** circa B.C. 139 † **15:18** 1,000 minas is about 499 kg. or about 1,098 pounds.

take vengeance on them according to their law."
22 He wrote the same things to King Demetrius, to Attalus, to Arathes, to Arsaces,
23 to all the countries, to‡ Sampsames, to the Spartans, to Delos, to Myndos, to Sicyon, to Caria, to Samos, to Pamphylia, to Lycia, to Halicarnassus, to Rhodes, to Phaselis, to Cos, to Side, to Aradus, Gortyna, Cnidus, Cyprus, and Cyrene.
24 They also wrote this copy to Simon the high priest.
25 But King Antiochus encamped against Dor the second day, bringing his forces up to it continually, and making engines of war; and he shut up Tryphon from going in or out.
26 Simon sent him two thousand chosen men to fight on his side, with silver, gold, and instruments of war in abundance.
27 He would not receive them, but nullified all the covenants which he had made with him before, and was estranged from him.
28 He sent to him Athenobius, one of his friends,§ to confer with him, saying, "You hold possession of Joppa, Gazara, and the citadel that is in Jerusalem, cities of my kingdom.
29 You have devastated their territory, and done great harm in the land, and control many places in my kingdom.
30 Now therefore hand over the cities which you have taken, and the tributes of the places which you have taken control of outside of the borders of Judea;
31 or else give me for them five hundred talents of silver; and for the harm that you have done, and the tributes of the cities, another five hundred talents. Otherwise we will come and subdue you."
32 Athenobius, the king's friend,† came to Jerusalem. When he saw the glory of Simon, the cupboard of gold and silver vessels, and his great attendance, he was amazed. He reported to him the king's words.
33 Simon answered, and said to him, "We have not taken other men's land nor do we have possession of that which belongs to others, but of the inheritance of our fathers. However, it had been in possession of our enemies wrongfully for a while.
34 But we, having opportunity, firmly hold the inheritance of our fathers.
35 As for Joppa and Gazara, which you demand, they did great harm among the people throughout our country. We will give one hundred talents for them."
Athenobius didn't answer even one word,
36 but returned in a rage to the king, and reported to him these words, and the glory of Simon, and all that he had seen; and the king was exceedingly angry.
37 Meanwhile, Tryphon embarked on board a ship, and fled to Orthosia.
38 The king appointed Cendebaeus chief captain of the sea coast, and gave him troops of infantry and cavalry.
39 He commanded him to encamp against Judea, and he commanded him to build up Kidron, and to fortify the gates, and that he should fight against the people; but the king pursued Tryphon.
40 So Cendebaeus came to Jamnia and began to provoke the people, and to invade Judea, and to take the people captive and kill them.
41 He built Kidron and stationed cavalry and infantry there, to the end that going out they might make raids on the highways of Judea, as the king had commanded him.

16

1 John went up from Gazara and told Simon his father what Cendebaeus was doing.
2 Simon called his two oldest sons, Judas and John, and said to them, "I and my brothers and my father's house have fought the battles of Israel from our youth, even to this day; and things have prospered in our hands, so that we have often delivered Israel.
3 But now I am old, and you moreover, by his mercy, are of a sufficient age. Take

‡ **15:23** Some authorities read *Sampsaces:* the Latin versions have *Lampsacus.*
† **15:32** See 1 Maccabees 2:18.
§ **15:28** See 1 Maccabees 2:18.

the place of me and my brother, and go
out and fight for our nation; and let the
help which is from heaven be with you.
4 He chose out of the country twenty
thousand men of war and cavalry, and
they went against Cendebaeus, and slept
at Modin.
5 Rising up in the morning, they went
into the plain, and, behold, a great army
of infantry and cavalry came to meet
them. There was a brook between them.
6 He encamped near them, he and his
people. He saw that the people were
afraid to pass over the brook, and he
passed over first. When the men saw him,
they passed over after him.
7 He divided the people, and placed the
cavalry in the midst of the infantry; but
the enemies' cavalry were exceedingly
many.
8 They sounded the trumpets; and
Cendebaeus and his army were put to
flight, and many of them fell wounded to
death, but those who were left fled to the
stronghold.
9 At that time Judas, John's brother, was
wounded; but John pursued after them
until he came to Kidron, which
Cendebaeus had built.
10 They fled to the towers that are in the
fields of Azotus; and he burned them with
fire. About two thousand men of them
fell. Then he returned into Judea in peace.
11 Ptolemy the son of Abubus had been
appointed governor over the plain of
Jericho, and he had much silver and gold;
12 for he was the high priest's son-in-law.
13 His heart was lifted up, and he
planned to make himself master of the
country, and he made deceitful plans
against Simon and his sons, to do away
with them.
14 Now Simon was visiting the cities that
were in the country, and attending to
their needs. He went down to
Jericho—himself with Mattathias and
Judas his sons—in the one hundred
seventy-seventh year,† in the eleventh
month, which is the month Sebat.
15 The son of Abubus received them
deceitfully into the little stronghold that is
called Dok, which he had built, and made
them a great banquet, and hid men there.
16 When Simon and his sons had drunk
freely, Ptolemy and his men rose up, took
their weapons, rushed in against Simon in
the banqueting place, and killed him, his
two sons, and some of his servants.
17 He committed a great iniquity, and
repaid evil for good.
18 Ptolemy wrote these things and sent
to the king, that he should send him forces
to aid him, and should deliver him their
country and the cities.
19 He sent others to Gazara to do away
with John. To the captains of thousands,
he sent letters to come to him, that he
might give them silver, gold, and gifts.
20 He sent others to take possession of
Jerusalem and the temple hill.
21 One ran before to Gazara, and told
John that his father and kindred had
perished, and that he has sent to kill you
also.
22 When he heard, he was greatly
shocked. He seized the men who came to
destroy him and killed them; for he
perceived that they were seeking to
destroy him.
23 And the rest of the acts of John and of
his wars and of his valiant deeds which he
did, and of the building of the walls which
he built, and of his achievements,
24 behold, they are written in the
chronicles‡ of his high priesthood, from
the time that he was made high priest
after his father.

† **16:14** circa B.C. 136. ‡ **16:24** Gr. *book of days.*

The Second Book of the Maccabees

The Second Book of the Maccabees is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Roman Catholic, Greek Orthodox, and Russian Orthodox Churches.

1 The kindred, the Jews who are in
Jerusalem and those who are in the
country of Judea, send greetings and good
peace to the kindred, the Jews who are
throughout Egypt.
2 May God do good to you, and
remember his covenant with Abraham,
Isaac, and Jacob, his faithful servants,
3 and give you all a heart to worship
him and do his will with a strong heart
and a willing soul.
4 May God open your heart to his law
and his statutes, and make peace,
5 and listen to your requests, and be
reconciled with you, and not forsake you
in an evil time.
6 Now we are praying for you here.
7 In the reign of Demetrius, in the one
hundred sixty-ninth year, we the Jews
have already written to you in the
suffering and in the distress that has come
upon us in these years, from the time that
Jason and his company revolted from the
holy land and the kingdom,
8 and set the gate on fire, and shed
innocent blood. We prayed to the Lord,
and were heard. We offered sacrifices
and meal offerings. We lit the lamps. We
set out the show bread.†
9 Now see that you keep the days of the
feast of tabernacles in the month Chislev
in the one hundred eighty-eighth year.

10 The people of Jerusalem and those
who are in Judea, with the senate and
Judas, to Aristobulus, King Ptolemy's
teacher, who is also of the stock of the
anointed priests, and to the Jews who are
in Egypt, we send greetings and health.
11 Having been saved by God out of
great perils, as men arrayed against a
king, we thank him greatly.
12 For he threw out into Persia those
who fought against us in the holy city.
13 For when the prince had come there,
with an army that seemed irresistible,
they were cut to pieces in the temple of
Nanaea by the treachery of Nanaea's
priests.
14 For Antiochus, on the pretense that he
would marry her, came into the place, he
and his friends who were with him, that
they might take a large part of the
treasures as a dowry.
15 And when the priests of Nanaea's
temple had set the treasures out, and he
had come there with a small company
within the wall of the sacred precinct,
they locked the temple when Antiochus
had come in.
16 Opening the secret door of the
paneled ceiling, they threw stones and
struck down the prince. They cut him and
his company in pieces, and cut off their
heads, and threw them to the people who
were outside.
17 Blessed be our God in all things, who
handed over those who had committed
impiety.
18 Since we are now about to celebrate
the purification of the temple in the
month Chislev, on the twenty-fifth day, we
thought it necessary to notify you, so that
you may also keep a feast of tabernacles,
and remember the fire which was given
when Nehemiah offered sacrifices, after
he had built both the temple and the altar.
19 For indeed when our fathers were
about to be led into the land of Persia, the
godly priests of that time took some of the
fire of the altar, and hid it secretly in the
hollow of a well that was without water,
where they made sure that the place was
unknown to anyone.
20 Now after many years, when it
pleased God, Nehemiah, having received
a charge from the king of Persia, sent in
quest of the fire the descendants of the
priests who hid it. When they declared to
us that they had found no fire, but thick
liquid,
21 he commanded them to draw some of
it out and bring it to him. When the

† **1:8** Gr. *loaves*

sacrifices had been offered, Nehemiah commanded the priests to sprinkle with that liquid both the wood and the things laid on it.
22 When that was done and some time had passed, and the sun shone out, which before was hidden with clouds, a great blaze was kindled, so that all men marveled.
23 The priests made a prayer while the sacrifice was being consumed—both the priests and all the others. Jonathan led and the rest responded, as Nehemiah did.
24 The prayer was like this: "O Lord, Lord God, the Creator of all things, who are awesome, strong, righteous, and merciful, who alone are King and gracious,
25 who alone supply every need, who alone are righteous, almighty, and eternal, you who save Israel out of all evil, who chose the ancestors and sanctified them,
26 accept the sacrifice for all your people Israel, and preserve your own portion, and consecrate it.
27 Gather together our scattered people, set at liberty those who are in bondage among the heathen, look upon those who are despised and abhorred, and let the heathen know that you are our God.
28 Punish those who oppress us and in arrogance shamefully entreat us.
29 Plant your people in your holy place, even as Moses said."
30 Then the priests sang the hymns.
31 As soon as the sacrifice was consumed, then Nehemiah commanded that the rest of the liquid be poured on large stones.
32 When this was done, a flame was kindled; but when the light from the altar shone back, it went out.
33 When the matter became known, and it was told the king of the Persians that, in the place where the priests who were led away had hid the fire, the liquid appeared which Nehemiah and those who were with him purified the sacrifice,
34 then the king enclosed the place and made it sacred after he had investigated the matter.
35 When the king would show favor to any, he would exchange many presents and give them some of this liquid.
36 Nehemiah and those who were with him called this thing "Nephthar", which is by interpretation, "Cleansing"; but most men call it Nephthai.

2

1 It is also found in the records that Jeremiah the prophet commanded those who were carried away to take some of the fire, as has been mentioned,
2 and how that the prophet charged those who were carried away, having given them the law, that they should not forget the statutes of the Lord or be led astray in their minds when they saw images of gold and silver, and their adornment.
3 With other such words he exhorted them, that the law should not depart from their hearts.
4 It was in the writing that the prophet, being warned by God, commanded that the tabernacle and the ark should follow with him,† when he went out to the mountain where Moses had gone up and saw God's inheritance.
5 Jeremiah came and found a cave, he brought the tabernacle, the ark, and the altar of incense into it; then he sealed the entrance.
6 Some of those who followed with him came there that they might mark the way, and could not find it.
7 But when Jeremiah learned about that, he rebuked them, saying, "The place shall be unknown until God gathers the people together again and shows mercy.
8 Then the Lord will disclose these things, and the glory of the Lord shall be seen with the cloud, as it was also shown to Moses, also as Solomon implored that the place might be consecrated greatly,
9 and it was also declared that he, having wisdom, offered a sacrifice of dedication, and of the finishing of the temple.
10 As Moses prayed to the Lord and fire came down out of heaven and consumed

† **2:4** Gr. *and when.* The Greek text here is probably corrupt.

the sacrifice, even so Solomon also
prayed, and the fire came down and
consumed the burnt offerings.
11 ‡Moses said, 'Because the sin offering
had not been eaten, it was consumed in
like manner.'
12 Likewise Solomon kept the eight
days."
13 The same things were reported both
in the public archives and in Nehemiah's
records, and also how he, founding a
library, gathered together the books
about the kings and prophets, and the
writings of David, and letters of kings
about sacred gifts.
14 In like manner Judas also gathered
together for us all those books that had
been scattered by reason of the war, and
they are still with us.
15 If therefore you have need of them,
send some people to bring them to you.
16 Seeing then that we are about to
celebrate the purification, we write to
you. You will therefore do well if you
celebrate the days.
17 Now God, who saved all his people,
and restored the heritage to all, with the
kingdom, the priesthood, and the
consecration,
18 even as he promised through the
law—in God have we hope, that he will
soon have mercy upon us, and gather us
together out of everywhere under heaven
into his holy place; for he delivered us out
of great evils, and purified the place.

———————

19 Now the things concerning Judas
Maccabaeus and his brothers, the
purification of the greatest temple, the
dedication of the altar,
20 and further the wars against
Antiochus Epiphanes and Eupator his son,
21 and the manifestations that came
from heaven to those who fought with
one another in brave deeds for the
religion of the Jews; so that, being but a
few, they seized the whole country,
chased the barbarous multitudes,
22 recovered again the temple
renowned all the world over, freed the
city, and restored the laws which were
about to be overthrown, seeing the Lord
became gracious to them with all
kindness.
23 These things which have been
declared by Jason of Cyrene in five books,
we will attempt to abridge in one book.
24 For having in view the confused mass
of the numbers, and the§ difficulty which
awaits those who would enter into the
narratives of the history, by reason of the
abundance of the matter,
25 we were careful that those who
choose to read may be attracted, and that
those who wish us well may find it easy to
recall, and that all readers may benefit.
26 Although to us, who have taken upon
ourselves the painful labor of the
abridgement, the task is not easy, but a
matter of sweat and sleeplessness,
27 even as it is no light thing to him who
prepares a banquet, and seeks the benefit
of others. Nevertheless, for the sake of the
gratitude of the many we will gladly
endure the painful labor,
28 leaving to the historian the exact
handling of every particular, and again
having no strength to fill in the outlines of
our abridgement.
29 For as the masterbuilder of a new
house must care for the whole structure,
and again he who undertakes to decorate
and paint it must seek out the things fit for
its adorning; even so I think it is also with
us.
30 To occupy the ground, and to indulge
in long discussions, and to be curious in
particulars, is fitting for the first author of
the history;
31 but to strive after brevity of
expression, and to avoid a labored
fullness in the treatment, is to be granted
to him who would bring a writing into a
new form.
32 Here then let's begin the narration,
only adding this much to that which has
already been said; for it is a foolish thing
to make a long prologue to the history,

‡ **2:11** See Leviticus 10:16 and 9:24. § **2:24** Or, weariness

and to abridge the history itself.

3

1 When the holy city was inhabited with unbroken peace and the laws were kept very well because of the godliness of Onias the high priest and his hatred of wickedness,
2 it came to pass that even the kings themselves honored the place and glorified the temple with the noblest presents,
3 so that even King Seleucus of Asia bore all the costs belonging to the services of the sacrifices out of his own revenues.
4 But a man named Simon of the tribe of Benjamin, having been made guardian of the temple, disagreed with the high priest about the ruling of the market in the city.
5 When he couldn't overcome Onias, he went to Apollonius of †Tarsus, who at that time was governor of Coelesyria and Phoenicia.
6 He brought him word how that the treasury in Jerusalem was full of untold sums of money, so that the multitude of the funds was innumerable, and that they didn't pertain to the account of the sacrifices, but that it was possible that these should fall under the king's power.
7 When Apollonius met the king, he informed him of the money about which he had been told. So the king appointed Heliodorus, who was his chancellor, and sent him with a command to accomplish the removal of the reported money.
8 So Heliodorus set out on his journey at once, ostensibly to visit the cities of Coelesyria and Phoenicia, but in fact to execute the king's purpose.
9 When he had come to Jerusalem and had been courteously received by the high priest of the city, he told him about the information which had been given, and declared why he had come; and he inquired if in truth these things were so.
10 The high priest explained to him that there were in the treasury deposits of widows and orphans,
11 and moreover some money belonging to Hyrcanus the son of Tobias, a man in very high place, not as that impious Simon falsely alleged; and that in all there were four hundred talents of silver and two hundred of gold,
12 and that it was altogether impossible that wrong should be done to those who had put trust in the holiness of the place, and in the majesty and inviolable sanctity of the temple, honored over all the world.
13 But Heliodorus, because of the king's command given him, said that in any case this money must be confiscated for the king's treasury.
14 So having appointed a day, he entered in to direct the inquiry concerning these matters; and there was no small distress throughout the whole city.
15 The priests, prostrating themselves before the altar in their priestly garments, and called toward heaven upon him who gave the law concerning deposits, that he should preserve these treasures safe for those who had deposited them.
16 Whoever saw the appearance of the high priest was wounded in mind; for his countenance and the change of his color betrayed the distress of his soul.
17 For a terror and a shuddering of the body had come over the man, by which the pain that was in his heart was plainly shown to those who looked at him.
18 Those who were in the houses rushed out in crowds to make a universal supplication, because the place was about to come into dishonor.
19 The women, girded with sackcloth under their breasts, thronged the streets. The virgins who were kept indoors ran together, some to the gates, others to the walls, and some looked out through the windows.
20 All, stretching out their hands toward heaven, made their solemn supplication.
21 Then it was pitiful to see the multitude prostrating themselves all mixed together, and the anxiety of the high priest in his great distress.
22 While therefore they called upon the

† **3:5** Greek *Thraseas*

Almighty Lord to keep the things entrusted to them ‡safe and secure for those who had entrusted them,
23 Heliodorus went on to execute that which had been decreed.
24 But when he was already present there with his guards near the treasury, the Sovereign of spirits and of all authority caused a great manifestation, so that all who had presumed to come with him, stricken with dismay at the power of God, fainted in terror.
25 For they saw a horse with a frightening rider, adorned with beautiful trappings, and he rushed fiercely and struck at Heliodorus with his forefeet. It seemed like he who sat on the horse had complete armor of gold.
26 Two others also appeared to him, young men notable in their strength, and beautiful in their glory, and splendid in their apparel, who stood by him on either side, and scourged him unceasingly, inflicting on him many sore stripes.
27 When he had fallen suddenly to the ground, and great darkness had come over him, his guards picked him up and put him on a stretcher,
28 and carried him—this man who had just now entered with a great retinue and all his guard into the aforesaid treasury, himself now brought to utter helplessness, manifestly made to recognize the sovereignty of God.
29 So, while he, through the working of God, speechless and bereft of all hope and deliverance, lay prostrate,
30 they blessed the Lord who acted marvelously for his own place. The temple, which a little before was full of terror and alarm, was filled with joy and gladness after the Almighty Lord appeared.
31 But quickly some of Heliodorus's familiar friends implored Onias to call upon the Most High to grant life to him who lay quite at the last gasp.
32 The high priest, secretly fearing lest the king might come to think that some treachery toward Heliodorus had been perpetrated by the Jews, brought a sacrifice for the recovery of the man.
33 But as the high priest was making the atoning sacrifice, the same young men appeared again to Heliodorus, arrayed in the same garments. They stood and said, "Give Onias the high priest great thanks, for for his sake the Lord has granted you life.
34 See that you, since you have been scourged from heaven, proclaim to all men the sovereign majesty of God." When they had spoken these words, they vanished out of sight.
35 So Heliodorus, having offered a sacrifice to the Lord and vowed §great vows to him who had saved his life, and having bidden Onias farewell, returned with his army to the king.
36 He testified to all men the works of the greatest God, which he had seen with his eyes.
37 When the king asked Heliodorus what sort of man was fit to be sent yet once again to Jerusalem, he said,
38 "If you have any enemy or conspirator against the state, send him there, and you will receive him back well scourged, if he even escapes with his life; because truly there is some power of God in that place.
39 For he who has his dwelling in heaven himself has his eyes on that place and helps it. Those who come to hurt it, he strikes and destroys."
40 This was the history of Heliodorus and the keeping of the treasury.

4

1 The previously mentioned Simon, who had given information about the money against his country, slandered Onias, saying that it was he who had incited Heliodorus and had been the real cause of these evils.
2 He dared to call him a conspirator against the state who was actually the benefactor of the city, the guardian of his fellow countrymen, and a zealot for the laws.

‡ **3:22** Gr. *safe with all security.* § **3:35** Gr. *greatest.*

3 When his hatred grew so great that
even murders were perpetrated through
one of Simon's approved agents,
4 Onias, seeing the danger of the
contention, and that †Apollonius the son
of Menestheus, the governor of Coelesyria
and Phoenicia, was increasing Simon's
malice,
5 appealed to the king, not to be an
accuser of his fellow-citizens, but looking
to the good of all the‡ people, both public
and private;
6 for he saw that without the king's
involvement it was impossible for the
state to obtain peace any more, and that
Simon would not cease from his madness.
7 When Seleucus was deceased, and
Antiochus, who was called Epiphanes,
succeeded to the kingdom, Jason the
brother of Onias supplanted his brother
in the high priesthood,
8 having promised to the king at an
audience three hundred sixty talents of
silver, and out of another fund eighty
talents.
9 In addition to this, he undertook to
assign one hundred fifty more, if it might
be allowed him §through the king's
authority to set him up a gymnasium and
a body of youths to be trained in it, and to
register the inhabitants of Jerusalem as
citizens of Antioch.
10 When the king had assented, and
Jason had taken possession of the office,
he immediately shifted those of his own
race to the Greek way of life.
11 Setting aside the royal ordinances of
special favor to the Jews, granted by the
means of John the father of Eupolemus,
who went on the mission to the Romans to
establish friendship and alliance, and
seeking to overthrow the lawful ways of
living, he brought in new customs
forbidden by the law.
12 For he eagerly established a
gymnasium under the citadel itself, and
caused the noblest of the young men to
wear the Greek hat.
13 Thus there was an extreme of
hellenization, and an advance of a foreign
religion, by reason of the exceeding
profaneness of Jason, who was an
ungodly man and not a high priest;
14 so that the priests had no more any
zeal for the services of the altar; but
despising the sanctuary and neglecting
the sacrifices, they hastened to enjoy that
which was unlawfully provided in the
wrestling arena, after the summons to the
discus-throwing.
15 They despised the honors of their
fathers, and valued the prestige of the
Greeks best of all.
16 For this reason, severe calamity
overtook them. The men whose ways of
living they earnestly followed, and to
whom they desired to be made like in all
things, these became their enemies and
punished them.
17 For it is not a light thing to show
irreverence to God's laws, but later events
will make this clear.
18 Now when certain games that came
every fifth year were kept at Tyre, and the
king was present,
19 the vile Jason sent sacred envoys,† as
being Antiochians of Jerusalem, bearing
three hundred drachmas of silver to the
sacrifice of Hercules, which even the
bearers thereof thought not right to use
for any sacrifice, because it was not fit,
but to spend it for another purpose.
20 Although the intended purpose of the
sender this money was for the sacrifice of
Hercules, yet on account of ‡present
circumstances it went to the construction
of trireme warships.
21 Now when Apollonius the son of
Menestheus was sent into Egypt for the
§enthronement of Philometor as king,
Antiochus, learning that Philometor had
shown himself hostile toward the
government, took precautions for the
security of his realm. Therefore, going to
Joppa, he travelled on to Jerusalem.

† **4:4** Compare 2 Maccabees 4:21. See also 2 Maccabees 3:5. The Greek as commonly read means *Apollonius, as* being *the governor...Phoenicia, did rage, and increase etc.* ‡ **4:5** Gr. *multitude.* § **4:9** Gr. *through his.* † **4:19** See ver. 9. ‡ **4:20** Some authorities read *the bearers.* § **4:21** The exact meaning of the Greek word is uncertain.

22 Being magnificently received by
Jason and the city, he was brought in with
torches and shouting. Then he led his
army down into Phoenicia.
23 Now after a space of three years,
Jason sent Menelaus, the previously
mentioned Simon's brother, to carry the
money to the king, and to make reports
concerning some necessary matters.
24 But he being commended to the king,
and having been glorified by the display
of his authority, secured the high
priesthood for himself, outbidding Jason
by three hundred talents of silver.
25 After receiving the royal mandates,
he returned bringing nothing worthy of
the high priesthood, but having the
passion of a cruel tyrant and the rage of a
savage animal.
26 So Jason, who had supplanted his
own brother, was supplanted by another
and driven as a fugitive into the country
of the Ammonites.
27 Menelaus had possession of the
office, but of the money that had been
promised to the king nothing was
regularly paid, even though Sostratus the
governor of the citadel demanded it—
28 for his job was the gathering of the
revenues—so they were both called by the
king to his presence.
29 Menelaus left his own brother
Lysimachus for his† deputy in the high
priesthood; and Sostratus left Crates, who
was over the Cyprians.
30 Now while this was the state of things,
it came to pass that the people of Tarsus
and Mallus revolted because they were to
be given as a present to Antiochis, the
king's concubine.
31 The king therefore quickly came to
settle matters, leaving for his ‡deputy
Andronicus, a man of high rank.
32 Then Menelaus, supposing that he
had gotten a favorable opportunity,
presented to Andronicus certain vessels
of gold belonging to the temple, which he
had stolen. He had already sold others
into Tyre and the neighboring cities.
33 When Onias had sure knowledge of
this, he sharply reproved him, having
withdrawn himself into a sanctuary at
Daphne, that lies by Antioch.
34 Therefore Menelaus, taking
Andronicus aside, asked him to kill Onias.
Coming to Onias, and being persuaded to
use treachery, and being received as a
friend, Andronicus gave him his right
hand with oaths and, though he was
suspicious, persuaded him to come out of
the sanctuary. Then, with no regard for
justice, he immediately put him to death.
35 For this reason not only Jews, but
many also of the other nations, had
indignation and displeasure at the unjust
murder of the man.
36 And when the king had come back
from the places in Cilicia, the Jews who
were in the city appealed to him against
Andronicus (the Greeks also joining with
them in hatred of the wickedness), urging
that Onias had been wrongfully slain.
37 Antiochus therefore was heartily
sorry, and was moved to pity, and wept,
because of the sober and well ordered life
of him who was dead.
38 Being inflamed with anger, he
immediately stripped off Andronicus's
purple robe, and tore off his under
garments, and when he had led him
round through the whole city to that very
place where he had committed the
outrage against Onias, there he put the
murderer out of the way, the Lord
rendering to him the punishment he had
deserved.
39 Now when many sacrileges had been
committed in the city by Lysimachus with
the consent of Menelaus, and when the
report of them had spread abroad
outside, the people gathered themselves
together against Lysimachus, after many
vessels of gold had already been stolen.
40 When the multitudes were rising
against him and were filled with anger,
Lysimachus armed about three thousand
men, and with unrighteous violence
began the attack under the leadership of
Hauran, a man far gone in years and no

† **4:29** Gr. *successor.* ‡ **4:31** Gr. *successor.*

less also in folly.
41 But when they perceived the assault
of Lysimachus, some caught up stones,
others logs of wood, and some took
handfuls of the ashes that lay near, and
they flung them all in wild confusion at
Lysimachus and those who were with
him.
42 As a result, they wounded many of
them, they killed some, and they forced
the rest of them to flee, but the author of
the sacrilege himself they killed beside
the treasury.
43 But about these matters, there was an
accusation laid against Menelaus.
44 When the king had come to Tyre, the
three men who were sent by the senate
pleaded the cause before him.
45 But Menelaus, seeing himself now
defeated, promised much money to
Ptolemy the son of Dorymenes, that he
might win over the king.
46 Therefore Ptolemy taking the king
aside into a cloister, as if to get some fresh
air, convinced him to change his mind.
47 He who was the cause of all the evil,
Menelaus, he discharged from the
accusations; but these hapless men, who,
if they had pleaded even before Scythians,
would have been discharged
uncondemned, them he sentenced to
death.
48 Those who were spokesmen for the
city and the families of Israel and the holy
vessels soon suffered that unrighteous
penalty.
49 Therefore even certain Tyrians,
moved with hatred of the wickedness,
provided magnificently for their burial.
50 But Menelaus, through the covetous
dealings of those who were in power,
remained still in his office, growing in
wickedness, established as a great
conspirator against his fellow-citizens.

5

1 Now about this time Antiochus made
his second invasion into Egypt.
2 It happened that throughout all the
city, for almost forty days, cavalry
appeared in the midst of the sky in swift
motion, wearing robes woven with gold
and carrying spears, equipped with
troops for battle—
3 drawing swords, squadrons of cavalry
in array, encounters and pursuits of both
armies, shaking shields, multitudes of
lances, throwing of missiles, flashing of
golden trappings, and putting on all sorts
of armor.
4 Therefore everyone prayed that the
manifestation might have been given for
good.
5 When a false rumor had arisen that
Antiochus was dead, Jason took not less
than a thousand men, and suddenly made
an assault upon the city. When those who
were on the wall were being routed, and
the city was at length nearly taken,
Menelaus took refuge in the citadel.
6 But Jason slaughtered his own citizens
without mercy, not considering that good
success against kinsmen is the greatest
misfortune, but supposing himself to be
setting up trophies over enemies, and not
over fellow-countrymen.
7 He didn't win control of the
government, but receiving shame as the
result of his conspiracy, he fled again as a
fugitive into the country of the
Ammonites.
8 At last therefore he met with a
miserable end. Having been imprisoned
at the court of Aretas the prince of the
Arabians, fleeing from city to city,
pursued by all men, hated as a rebel
against the laws, and abhorred as the
executioner of his country and his fellow
citizens, he was cast ashore in Egypt.
9 He who had driven many from their
own country into exile perished in exile,
having crossed the sea to the
Lacedaemonians, hoping to find shelter
there because they were† near of kin.
10 He who had thrown out a multitude
unburied had none to mourn for him. He
didn't have any funeral at all and no place
in the tomb of his ancestors.
11 Now when news came to the king
concerning that which was done, he

† **5:9** See 1 Maccabees 12:7.

thought that Judea was in revolt. So, setting out from Egypt in a rage, he took the city by force of weapons,
12 and commanded his soldiers to cut down without mercy those who came in their way, and to kill those who went into their houses.
13 Then there was killing of young and old, destruction of boys, women, and children, and slaying of virgins and infants.
14 In a total of three days, eighty thousand were destroyed, of which forty thousand were slain in close combat, and no fewer were sold into slavery than slain.
15 Not content with this, he presumed to enter into the most holy temple of all the earth, having Menelaus for his guide (who had proved himself a traitor both to the laws and to his country),
16 even taking the sacred vessels with his polluted hands, and dragging down with his profane hands the offerings that had been dedicated by other kings to enhance the glory and honor of the place.
17 Antiochus was lifted up in mind, not seeing that because of the sins of those who lived in the city the Sovereign Lord had been provoked to anger a little while, and therefore his eye was turned away from the place.
18 But had it not been so that they were already bound by many sins, this man, even as Heliodorus who was sent by King Seleucus to view the treasury, would, as soon as he came forward, have been scourged and turned back from his daring deed.
19 However the Lord didn't choose the nation for the place's sake, but the place for the nation's sake.
20 Therefore also the place itself, having shared in the calamities that happened to the nation, did afterward share in its benefits; and the place which was forsaken in the wrath of the Almighty was, at the reconciliation of the great Sovereign, restored again with all glory.
21 As for Antiochus, when he had carried away out of the temple one thousand eight hundred talents, he hurried away to Antioch, thinking in his arrogance that he could sail on land and walk on the sea, because his heart was lifted up.
22 Moreover he left governors to afflict the race: at Jerusalem, Philip, by race a Phrygian, and in character more barbarous than him who set him there;
23 and at Gerizim, Andronicus; and besides these, Menelaus, who worse than all the rest, exalted himself against his fellow-citizens. Having a malicious mind‡ toward the Jews§ whom he had made his citizens,
24 he sent that† lord of pollutions Apollonius with an army of twenty-two thousand, commanding him to kill all those who were of full age, and to sell the women and the boys as slaves.
25 He came to Jerusalem, and pretending to be a man of peace, waited till the holy day of the Sabbath, and finding the Jews at rest from work, he commanded his men to parade fully armed.
26 He put to the sword all those who came out to the spectacle. Running into the city with the armed men, he killed great multitudes.
27 But Judas, who is also called Maccabaeus, with about nine others, withdrew himself, and with his company kept himself alive in the mountains like wild animals do. They continued feeding on what grew wild, that they might not be partakers of the defilement.

6

1 Not long after this, the king sent out †an old man of Athens to compel the Jews to depart from the laws of their fathers and not to live by the laws of God,
2 and also to pollute the sanctuary in Jerusalem and to call it by the name of Olympian Zeus, and to call the sanctuary

‡ **5:23** Some authorities read *toward the Jews, he sent.* The Greek text of this sentence is uncertain. § **5:23** Compare 2 Maccabees 4:9, 19; 9:19. † **5:24** Gr. *Μυσάρχην,* which also may mean *ruler of the Mysians.* † **6:1** Or, *Geron an Athenian*

in Gerizim by the name of Zeus the Protector of foreigners, even as the people who lived in that place did.
3 The visitation of this evil was harsh and utterly grievous.
4 For the temple was filled with debauchery and reveling by the heathen, who ‡dallied with prostitutes, and had intercourse with women within the sacred precincts, and moreover brought inside things that were not appropriate.
5 The altar was filled with those abominable things which had been prohibited by the laws.
6 A man could neither keep the Sabbath, nor observe the feasts of their ancestors, nor so much as confess himself to be a Jew.
7 On the day of the king's birth every month, they were led along with bitter constraint to eat of the sacrifices. When the feast of Dionysia came, they were compelled to go in procession in honor of Dionysus, wearing wreaths of ivy.
8 A decree went out to the neighboring Greek cities, by the suggestion of Ptolemy, that they should observe the same conduct against the Jews, and should make them eat of the sacrifices,
9 and that they should kill those who didn't choose to go over to the Greek rites. So the present misery was for all to see.
10 For example, two women were brought in for having circumcised their children. These, when they had led them publicly around the city with the babes hung from their breasts, they threw down headlong from the wall.
11 Others who had run together into the caves nearby to keep the seventh day secretly, were betrayed to Philip and were all burned together, because their piety kept them from defending themselves, in view of the honor of that most solemn day.
12 I urge those who read this book to not be discouraged because of the calamities, but recognize that these punishments were not for the destruction, but for the chastening of our race.
13 For indeed it is a sign of great kindness that those who act impiously are not let alone for a long time, but immediately meet with retribution.
14 For in the case of the other nations, the Sovereign Lord waits patiently to punish them until they have attained to the full measure of their sins; but not with us,
15 that he may not take vengeance on us afterward,§ when we have come to the† height of our sins.
16 Therefore he never withdraws his mercy from us; but though he chastens with calamity, he doesn't forsake his own people.
17 However let this that we have spoken suffice to remind you; but after a few words, we must come to the narrative.
18 Eleazar, one of the principal scribes, a man already well advanced in years, and of a noble countenance, was compelled to open his mouth to eat swine's flesh.
19 But he, welcoming death with honor rather than life with defilement, advanced of his own accord to the instrument of torture, but first spat out the flesh,
20 as men ought to come who are resolute to repel such things as not even for the natural love of life is it lawful to taste.
21 But those who had the charge of that forbidden sacrificial feast took the man aside, for the acquaintance which of old times they had with him, and privately implored him to bring flesh of his own providing, such as was proper for him to use, and to make as if he did eat of the flesh from the sacrifice, as had been commanded by the king;
22 that by so doing he might be delivered from death, and so his ancient friendship with them might be treated kindly.
23 But he, having formed a high resolve, and one that became his years, the dignity of old age, and the gray hairs‡ which he had reached with honor, and his excellent§ education from a child, or

‡ **6:4** Or, *idled with their fellows* § **6:15** Or, *when our sins have come to their height* † **6:15** Gr. *end.* ‡ **6:23** The Greek text appears to be corrupt. § **6:23** Some authorities read *manner of life.* † **6:23** Gr. *legislation.*

rather the holy laws† of God's ordaining, declared his mind accordingly, bidding them to quickly send him to Hades.
24 "For it doesn't become our years to dissemble," he said, "that many of the young should suppose that Eleazar, the man of ninety years, had gone over to an alien religion;
25 and so they, by reason of my deception, and for the sake of this brief and momentary life, would be led astray because of me, and I defile and disgrace myself in my old age.
26 For even if for the present time I would remove from me the punishment of men, yet whether I live or die, I wouldn't escape the hands of the Almighty.
27 Therefore, by bravely parting with my life now, I will show myself worthy of my old age,
28 and ‡leave behind a noble example to the young to die willingly and nobly a glorious death for the revered and holy laws."
When he had said these words, he went immediately to the instrument of torture.
29 §When they changed the good will they bore toward him a little before into ill will because these words of his were, as they thought, sheer madness,
30 and when he was at the point to die with the† blows, he groaned aloud and said, "To the Lord, who has the holy knowledge, it is manifest that, while I might have been delivered from death, I endure severe pains in my body by being scourged; but in soul I gladly suffer these things because of my fear of him."
31 So this man also died like this, leaving his death for an example of nobleness and a memorial of virtue, not only to the young but also to the great body of his nation.

7

1 It came to pass that seven brothers and their mother were at the king's command taken and shamefully handled with scourges and cords, to compel them to taste of the abominable swine's flesh.
2 One of them made himself the spokesman and said, "What would you ask and learn from us? For we are ready to die rather than transgress the laws of our ancestors."
3 The king fell into a rage, and commanded that pans and caldrons be heated.
4 When these were immediately heated, he gave orders to cut out the tongue of him who had been their spokesman, and to scalp him, and to cut off his extremities, with the rest of his brothers and his mother looking on.
5 And when he was utterly† maimed, the king gave orders to bring him to the fire, being yet alive, and to fry him in the pan. And as the smoke from the pan spread far, they and their mother also exhorted one another to die nobly, saying this:
6 "The Lord God sees, and in truth is‡ entreated for us, as Moses declared in §his song, which witnesses against the people to their faces, saying, 'And he will have compassion on his servants.' "
7 And when the first had died like this, they brought the second to the mocking; and they pulled off the skin of his head with the hair and asked him, "Will you eat, before your body is punished in every limb?"
8 But he answered in the language of his ancestors and said to them, "No." Therefore he also underwent the next torture in succession, as the first had done.
9 When he was at the last gasp, he said, "You, miscreant, release us out of this present life, but the King of the world will raise us who have died for his laws up to an everlasting renewal of life."
10 After him, the third was made a victim of their mocking. When he was required, he quickly put out his tongue, and stretched out his hands courageously,
11 and nobly said, "I got these from heaven. For his laws' sake I treat these

‡ **6:28** Gr. *one that has left behind.* § **6:29** The Greek text of this verse is uncertain. † **6:30** Or, *blows* † **7:5** Gr. *useless.* ‡ **7:6** Or, *comforted in* § **7:6** See Deuteronomy 31:21 and 32:36.

with contempt. From him, I hope to
receive these back again."
12 As a result, the king himself and those
who were with him were astonished at
the young man's soul, for he regarded the
pains as nothing.
13 When he too was dead, they
shamefully handled and tortured the
fourth in the same way.
14 Being near to death he said this: "It is
good to die at the hands of men and look
for the hope which is given by God, that
we will be raised up again by him. For as
for you, you will have no resurrection to
life."
15 Next after him, they brought the fifth
and shamefully handled him.
16 But he looked toward †the king and
said, "Because you have authority among
men, though you are corruptible, you do
what you please. But don't think that our
race has been forsaken by God.
17 But hold on to your ways, and see
how his sovereign majesty will torture
you and your descendants!"
18 After him they brought the sixth.
When he was about to die, he said, "Don't
be vainly deceived, for we suffer these
things for our own doings, as sinning
against our own God. Astounding things
have come to pass;
19 but don't think that you will be
unpunished, having tried to fight against
God!"
20 But above all, the mother was
marvelous and worthy of honorable
memory; for when she watched seven
sons perishing within the space of one
day, she bore the sight with a good
courage because of her hope in the Lord.
21 She exhorted each one of them in the
language of their fathers, filled with a
noble spirit and stirring up her woman's
thoughts with manly courage, saying to
them,
22 "I don't know how you came into my
womb. It wasn't I who gave you your
‡spirit and your life. It wasn't I who
brought into order the first elements of
each one of you.
23 Therefore the Creator of the world,
who shaped the first origin of man and
devised the first origin of all things, in
mercy gives back to you again both your
§spirit and your life, as you now treat
yourselves with contempt for his laws'
sake."
24 But Antiochus, thinking himself to be
despised, and suspecting the reproachful
voice, while the youngest was yet alive
didn't only make his appeal to him by
words, but also at the same time promised
with oaths that he would enrich him and†
raise him to high honor if he would turn
from the ways of his ancestors, and that
he would take him for his ‡friend and
entrust him with public affairs.
25 But when the young man would in no
way listen, the king called to him his
mother, and urged her to advise the youth
to save himself.
26 When he had urged her with many
words, she undertook to persuade her
son.
27 But bending toward him, laughing
the cruel tyrant to scorn, she spoke this in
the language of her fathers: "My son, have
pity upon me who carried you nine
months in my womb, and nursed you
three years, and nourished and brought
you up to this age, and sustained you.
28 I beg you, my child, to lift your eyes to
the sky and the earth, and to see all things
that are in it, and thus to recognize that
God made them not of things that were,
and that the race of men in this way
comes into being.
29 Don't be afraid of this butcher, but,
proving yourself worthy of your brothers,
accept your death, that in God's mercy I
may receive you again with your
brothers."
30 But before she had finished speaking,
the young man said, "What are you all
waiting for? I don't obey the
commandment of the king, but I listen to
the commandment of the law that was
given to our fathers through Moses.

† **7:16** Gr. *him.* ‡ **7:22** Or, *breath* § **7:23** Or, *breath* † **7:24** Gr. *make him one that is counted happy.* ‡ **7:24** See 2 Maccabees 8:9.

31 But you, who have devised all kinds
of evil against the Hebrews, will in no way
escape God's hands.
32 For we are suffering because of our
own sins.
33 If for rebuke and chastening, our
living Lord has been angered a little
while, yet he will again be reconciled with
his own servants.
34 But you, O unholy man and of all most
vile, don't be vainly lifted up in your wild
pride with uncertain hopes, raising your
hand against the heavenly children.
35 For you have not yet escaped the
judgment of the Almighty God who sees
all things.
36 For these our brothers, having
endured a §short pain that brings
everlasting life, have now †died under
God's covenant. But you, through God's
judgment, will receive in just measure the
penalties of your arrogance.
37 But I, as my brothers, give up both
body and soul for the laws of our fathers,
calling upon God that he may speedily
become ‡gracious to the nation, and that
you, amidst trials and plagues, may
confess that he alone is God,
38 and that in me and my brothers §you
may bring to an end the wrath of the
Almighty which has been justly brought
upon our whole race."
39 But the king, falling into a rage,
handled him worse than all the rest, being
exasperated at his mocking.
40 So he also died pure, putting his
whole trust in the Lord.
41 Last of all, after her sons, the mother
died.
42 Let it then suffice to have said thus
much concerning the sacrificial feasts and
the extreme tortures.

8

1 But Judas, who is also called
Maccabaeus, and those who were with
him, making their way secretly into the
villages, called together their kindred.
Enlisting those who had continued in the
Jews' religion, they gathered together
about six thousand.
2 They called upon the Lord to look at
the people who were oppressed by all, and
to have compassion on the sanctuary that
had been profaned by the ungodly men,
3 and to have pity on the city that was
suffering ruin and ready to be leveled to
the ground, and to listen to the blood that
cried out to him,
4 and to remember the lawless
destruction of the innocent infants, and
concerning the blasphemies that had
been committed against his name, and to
show his hatred of wickedness.

5 When Maccabaeus had trained his
men for service, the heathen at once
found him irresistible, for the wrath of the
Lord was turned into mercy.
6 †Coming without warning, he set fire
to cities and villages. And in winning back
the most important positions, putting to
flight no small number of the enemies,
7 he especially took advantage of the
nights for such assaults. His courage was
loudly talked of everywhere.

8 But when Philip saw the man gaining
ground little by little, and increasing more
and more in his success, he wrote to
Ptolemy, the governor of Coelesyria and
Phoenicia, that he should support the
king's cause.
9 Ptolemy quickly appointed Nicanor
the son of Patroclus, one of the king's
‡chief friends, and sent him, in command
of no fewer than twenty thousand of all
nations, to destroy the whole race of
Judea. With him he joined Gorgias also, a
captain and one who had experience in
matters of war.
10 Nicanor resolved by the sale of the
captive Jews to make up for the king the
tribute of two thousand talents which he
was to pay to the Romans.

§ **7:36** Gr. *short pain of ever-flowing life.* † **7:36** Gr. *fallen.* By the omission of one Greek letter the words would signify *having endured a short pain, have now drunk of ever-flowing life under God's covenant.* ‡ **7:37** Gr. *propitious.*

§ **7:38** Some authorities read *may be stayed.* † **8:6** The Greek text of verses 6 and 7 is uncertain. ‡ **8:9** See 1 Maccabees 10:65. Compare 2 Maccabees 1:14; 7:24; 10:13; 14:11; 1 Maccabees 2:18. § **8:11** Gr. *bodies.*

11 Immediately he sent to the cities upon
the sea coast, inviting them to buy Jewish
§slaves, promising to deliver seventy
†slaves for a talent, not expecting the
judgment that was to overtake him from
the Almighty.

12 News came to Judas concerning
Nicanor's invasion. When he
communicated to those who were with
him the presence of the army,

13 those who were cowardly and
distrustful of God's judgment ‡ran away
and left the country.

14 Others sold all that they had left, and
at the same time implored the Lord to
deliver those who had been sold as slaves
by the impious Nicanor before he ever
met them,

15 if not for their own sakes, then for the
covenants made with their ancestors, and
because he had called them by his holy
and glorious name.

16 So Maccabaeus gathered his men
together, six thousand in number, and
exhorted them not to be frightened by the
enemy, nor to fear the great multitude of
the heathen who came wrongfully against
them, but to fight nobly,

17 setting before their eyes the outrage
that had been lawlessly perpetrated upon
the holy place, and the torture of the city
that had been turned to mockery, and
further the overthrow of the way of life
received from their ancestors.

18 "For they," he said, "trust their
weapons and daring deeds, but we trust
in the almighty God, since he is able at a
nod to cast down those who are coming
against us, and even the whole world."

19 Moreover, he recounted to them the
help given from time to time in the days of
their ancestors, both in the days of
Sennacherib, when one hundred
eighty-five thousand perished,

20 and in the land of Babylon, in the
battle that was fought against the§ Gauls,
how they came to the battle with eight
thousand in all, with four thousand
Macedonians, and how, the Macedonians
being hard pressed, the †six thousand
destroyed the hundred and twenty
thousand because of the help which they
had from heaven, and took a great deal of
plunder.

21 And when he had with these words
filled them with courage and made them
ready to die for the laws and their
country, he divided his army into four
parts.

22 He appointed his brothers, Simon,
Joseph, and Jonathan, to be leaders of the
divisions with him, giving each the
command of one thousand five hundred
men.

23 Moreover Eleazer also, having read
aloud the sacred book, and having given
as watchword, "THE HELP OF GOD",
leading the first band himself, joined
battle with Nicanor.

24 Since the Almighty fought on their
side, they killed more than nine thousand
of the enemy, and wounded and‡ disabled
most of Nicanor's army, and compelled
them all to flee.

25 They took the money of those who
had come there to buy them as slaves.
After they had pursued them for some
§distance, they returned, being
constrained by the time of the day;

26 for it was the day before the Sabbath,
and for this reason they made no effort to
chase them far.

27 †When they had gathered ‡the
weapons of the enemy together, and had
stripped off their spoils, they kept the
Sabbath, greatly blessing and thanking
the Lord who had saved them to this day,
because he had begun to show mercy to
them.

28 After the Sabbath, when they had
given some of the spoils to the §maimed,
and to the widows and orphans, they
distributed the rest among themselves
and their children.

† **8:11** Gr. *bodies.* ‡ **8:13** The Greek text here is uncertain. § **8:20** Gr. *Galatians.* † **8:20** Some authorities read *eight.* ‡ **8:24** Gr. *disabled in their limbs.* § **8:25** Or, *while* † **8:27** The exact meaning of this clause is uncertain. ‡ **8:27** Gr. *their weapons...the spoils of the enemy.* § **8:28** Or, *wounded* Gr. *shamefully handled.*

29 When they had accomplished these
things and had made a common
supplication, they implored the merciful
Lord to be wholly reconciled with his
servants.
30 Having had an encounter with the
forces of Timotheus and Bacchides, they
killed more than twenty thousand of
them, and made themselves masters of
exceedingly high strongholds, and
divided very much plunder, giving the
†maimed, orphans, widows, and the aged
an equal share with themselves.
31 ‡When they had gathered the
weapons §of the enemy together, they
stored them all up carefully in the most
strategic positions, and they carried the
rest of the spoils to Jerusalem.
32 They killed the †phylarch of
Timotheus's forces, a most unholy man,
and one who had done the Jews much
harm.
33 ‡As they celebrated the feast of victory
in the §city of their fathers, they burned
those who had set the sacred †gates on
fire, including Callisthenes, who had fled
into ‡a little house. So they received the
proper reward for their impiety.
34 The thrice-accursed Nicanor, who
had brought the thousand merchants to
buy the Jews as slaves,
35 being through the help of the Lord
humbled by them who in his eyes were
held to be of least account, took off his
glorious apparel, and passing through the
country, §shunning all company like a
fugitive slave, arrived at Antioch, †having,
as he thought, had the greatest possible
good fortune, though his army was
destroyed.
36 He who had taken upon himself to
make tribute sure for the Romans by the
captivity of the men of Jerusalem
published abroad that the Jews had One
who fought for them, and that ‡because
this was so, the Jews were invulnerable,
because they followed the laws ordained
by him.

9

1 Now about that time, Antiochus
retreated †in disorder from the region of
Persia.
2 For he had entered into the city called
Persepolis, and he attempted to rob ‡a
temple and to control the city. Therefore
the multitudes rushed in and the people
of the country turned to defend
themselves with weapons; and it came to
pass that Antiochus was put to flight by
the people of the country and broke his
camp with disgrace.
3 While he was at Ecbatana, news was
brought to him about what had happened
to Nicanor and the forces of Timotheus.
4 Being overcome by his anger, he
planned to make the Jews suffer for the
evil deeds of those who had put him to
flight. Therefore, with judgment from
heaven even now accompanying him, he
ordered his charioteer to drive without
ceasing until he completed the journey;
for he arrogantly said this: "I will make
Jerusalem a common graveyard of Jews
when I come there."
5 But the All-seeing Lord, the God of
Israel, struck him with a §fatal and
invisible stroke. As soon as he had
finished speaking this word, an incurable
pain of the bowels seized him, with bitter
torments of the inner parts—
6 and that most justly, for he had
tormented other men's bowels with many
and strange sufferings.
7 But he in no way ceased from his rude
insolence. No, he was filled with even
more arrogance, breathing fire in his
passion against the Jews, and giving
orders to hasten the journey. But it came
to pass moreover that he fell from his
chariot as it rushed along, and having a

† **8:30** Or, *wounded* Gr. *shamefully handled.* ‡ **8:31** The exact meaning of this clause is uncertain. § **8:31** Gr. *of them.* † **8:32** That is, probably, the captain of an irregular auxiliary force. Some write *Phylarches,* as a proper name. ‡ **8:33** The Greek text here is perhaps corrupt. § **8:33** Or, *country* † **8:33** Or, *porches* ‡ **8:33** Or, *a solitary hut* § **8:35** Gr. *having made himself solitary.* † **8:35** Or, *having won the greatest possible favor by reason of the destruction of his army* ‡ **8:36** Or, *because of this* their *way of life* Gr. *because of this manner.* † **9:1** Or, *with dishonor* ‡ **9:2** Or, *temples* § **9:5** Gr. *remediless.*

grievous fall was tortured in all of the members of his body.

8 He who had just supposed himself to have the waves of the sea at his bidding because he was so superhumanly arrogant, and who thought to weigh the heights of the mountains in a balance, was now brought to the ground and carried in a litter, †showing to all that the power was obviously God's,

9 so that worms swarmed out of the impious man's body, and while he was still living in anguish and pains, his flesh fell off, and by reason of the stench all the army turned with loathing from his decay.

10 The man who a little before supposed himself to touch the stars of heaven, no one could endure to carry because of his intolerable stench.

11 Therefore he began in great part to cease from his arrogance, being broken in spirit, and to come to knowledge under the scourge of God, his pains increasing every moment.

12 When he himself could not stand his own smell, he said these words: "It is right to be subject to God, and that one who is mortal should not think they are equal to God."

13 The vile man vowed to the sovereign Lord, who now no more would have pity upon him, saying

14 that the holy city, to which he was going in haste to lay it even with the ground and to ‡make it a common graveyard, he would declare free.

15 Concerning the Jews, whom he had decided not even to count worthy of burial, but to cast them out to the animals with their infants for the birds to devour, he would make them all equal to citizens of Athens.

16 The holy sanctuary, which before he had plundered, he would adorn with best offerings, and would restore all the sacred vessels many times multiplied, and out of his own revenues would defray the charges that were required for the sacrifices.

17 Beside all this, he said that he would become a Jew and would visit every inhabited place, proclaiming the power of God.

18 But when his sufferings did in no way cease, for the judgment of God had come upon him in righteousness, having given up all hope for himself, he wrote to the Jews the letter written below, having the nature of a supplication, to this effect:

19 "To the worthy Jewish citizens, Antiochus, king and general, wishes much joy and health and prosperity.

20 May you and your children fare well, and may your affairs be as you wish. Having my hope in heaven,

21 I remembered with affection your honor and good will. Returning out of the region of Persia, and being taken with an annoying sickness, I deemed it necessary to take thought for the common safety of all,

22 not despairing of myself, but having great hope to escape from the sickness.

23 But considering that my father also, at the time he led an army into the upper country, appointed his successor,

24 to the end that, if anything fell out contrary to expectation, or if any unwelcome tidings were brought, the people in the country, knowing to whom the state had been left, might not be troubled,

25 and, moreover, observing how the princes who are along the borders and neighbors to my kingdom watch for opportunities and look for the future event, I have appointed my son Antiochus to be king, whom I often entrusted and commended to most of you when I was hurrying to the upper provinces. I have written to him what is written below.

26 I therefore urge you and beg you, having in your remembrance the benefits done to you in common and severally, to preserve your present good will, each of you, toward me and my son.

27 For I am persuaded that he in gentleness and kindness will follow my purpose and treat you with moderation

† **9:8** Or, *showing manifestly to all the power of God* ‡ **9:14** Gr. *build.*

and kindness.
28 So the murderer and blasphemer,
having endured the most intense
sufferings, even as he had dealt with other
men, ended his life among the mountains
by a most piteous fate in a strange land.
29 Philip his foster brother took the body
home and then, fearing the son of
Antiochus, he withdrew himself to
Ptolemy Philometor in Egypt.

10

1 Then Maccabaeus and those who were
with him, the Lord leading them on,
recovered the temple and the city.
2 They pulled down the altars that had
been built in the marketplace by the
foreigners, and also the sacred enclosures.
3 Having cleansed the sanctuary, they
made another altar of sacrifice. †Striking
flint and starting a fire, they offered
sacrifices after they had ceased for two
years, burned incense, lit lamps, and set
out the show bread.
4 When they had done these things, they
fell prostrate and implored the Lord that
they might fall no more into such evils;
but that, if they ever did sin, they might be
chastened by him with forbearance, and
not be delivered to blaspheming and
barbarous heathen.
5 Now on the same day that the
sanctuary was profaned by foreigners,
upon that very day it came to pass that the
sanctuary was cleansed, even on the
twenty-fifth day of the same month,
which is Chislev.
6 They observed eight days with
gladness in the manner of the feast of
tabernacles, remembering how ‡not long
before, during the feast of tabernacles,
they were wandering in the mountains
and in the caves like wild animals.
7 Therefore carrying wands wreathed
with leaves, and beautiful branches, and
palm fronds also, they offered up hymns
of thanksgiving to him who had
successfully brought to pass the cleansing
of his own place.
8 They ordained also with a public
statute and decree, for all the nation of the
Jews, that they should observe these days
every year.
9 Such were the events of the end of
Antiochus, who was called Epiphanes.
10 Now we will declare what came to
pass under Antiochus §Eupator, who
proved himself a son of that ungodly man,
and will summarize the main evils of the
wars.
11 For this man, when he succeeded to
the kingdom, appointed one Lysias to be
chancellor and supreme governor of
Coelesyria and Phoenicia.
12 For Ptolemy who was called Macron,
setting an example of observing justice
toward the Jews because of the wrong
that had been done to them, endeavored
to deal with them on peaceful terms.
13 Whereupon being accused by the
king's †friends before Eupator, and
hearing himself called traitor at every
turn because he had abandoned Cyprus
which Philometor had entrusted to him,
and had withdrawn himself to Antiochus
Epiphanes, and ‡failing to uphold the
honor of his office, he took poison and did
away with himself.
14 But when Gorgias was made
governor of the district, he maintained a
force of mercenaries, and at every turn
kept up war with the Jews.
15 Together with him the Idumaeans
also, being masters of important
strongholds, harassed the Jews; and
received those who had taken refuge
from Jerusalem, they endeavored to keep
up the war.
16 But Maccabaeus and his men, having
made solemn supplication and having
implored God to fight on their side, rushed
upon the strongholds of the Idumaeans.
17 Assaulting them vigorously, they took
control of the positions, and kept off all
who fought upon the wall, and killed
those whom they encountered, killing no
fewer than twenty thousand.

† **10:3** Gr. *firing.* ‡ **10:6** Or, *not long before they kept the feast of tabernacles by wandering* § **10:10** That is, *son of a good father.* † **10:13** See 2 Maccabees 8:9 ‡ **10:13** The Greek text here is corrupt.

18 Because no fewer than nine thousand had fled into two very strong towers having everything needed for a siege,
19 Maccabaeus, having left Simon and Joseph, and also Zacchaeus and those who were with him, a force sufficient to besiege them, departed himself to places where he was most needed.
20 But Simon and those who were with him, yielding to covetousness, were bribed by some of those who were in the towers, and receiving seventy thousand drachmas, let some of them slip away.
21 But when word was brought to Maccabaeus of what was done, he gathered the leaders of the people together, and accused those men of having sold their kindred for money by setting their enemies free to fight against them.
22 So he killed these men for having turned traitors, and immediately took possession of the two towers.
23 Prospering with his weapons in everything he undertook, he destroyed more than twenty thousand in the two strongholds.

24 Now Timotheus, who had been defeated by the Jews before, having gathered together foreign forces in great multitudes, and having collected the cavalry which belonged to Asia, not a few, came as though he would take Judea by force of weapons.
25 But as he drew near, Maccabaeus and his men sprinkled dirt on their heads and girded their loins with sackcloth, in supplication to God,
26 and falling down upon the step in front of the altar, implored him to become §gracious to them, and †be an enemy to their enemies and an adversary to their adversaries, as the law declares.
27 Rising from their prayer they took up their weapons, and advanced some distance from the city. When they had come near to their enemies, they‡ halted.
28 When the dawn was now breaking, the two armies joined in battle, the one part having this, beside virtue, for a pledge of success and victory, that they had fled to the Lord for refuge, the others making their passion their leader in the fight.
29 When the battle became strong, there appeared out of heaven to their adversaries five splendid men on horses with bridles of gold, §and two of them, leading on the Jews,
30 and taking Maccabaeus in the midst of them, and covering him with their own armor, guarded him from wounds, while they shot arrows and thunderbolts at the enemies. For this reason, they were blinded and thrown into confusion, and were cut to pieces, filled with bewilderment.
31 Twenty thousand five hundred were slain, beside six hundred cavalry.
32 Timotheus himself fled into a stronghold called Gazara, a fortress of great strength, †where Chaereas was in command.
33 Then Maccabaeus and his men were glad and laid siege to the fortress for four days.
34 Those who were within, trusting in the strength of the place, blasphemed exceedingly, and hurled out impious words.
35 But at dawn of the fifth day, certain young men of Maccabaeus' company, inflamed with anger because of the blasphemies, assaulted the wall with masculine force and with ‡furious anger, and cut down whoever came in their way.
36 Others climbing up in the same way, while the enemies were distracted with those who had made their way within, set fire to the towers, and kindled fires that burned the blasphemers alive, while others broke open the gates, and, having given entrance to the rest of the band, occupied the city.
37 They killed Timotheus, who was hidden in a cistern, and his brother Chaereas, and Apollophanes.

§ **10:26** Gr. *propitious.* † **10:26** See Exodus 23:22. ‡ **10:27** Gr. *were by themselves.* § **10:29** Some authorities read *and leading on the Jews; who also, taking.* † **10:32** See ver. 37. ‡ **10:35** Gr. *passion as of wild animals.*

38 When they had accomplished these
things, they blessed the Lord with hymns
and thanksgiving, blessing him who
provides great benefits to Israel and gives
them the victory.

11

1 Now after a very little time, Lysias, the
king's guardian, kinsman, and chancellor,
being very displeased about the things
that had happened,
2 collected about eighty thousand
infantry and all his cavalry and came
against the Jews, planing to make the city
a home for Greeks,
3 and to levy tribute on the temple, as
†on the other sacred places of the nations,
and to put up the high priesthood for sale
every year.
4 He took no account of God's power,
but was puffed up with his ten thousands
of infantry, his thousands of cavalry, and
his eighty elephants.
5 Coming into Judea and approaching
Bethsuron, which was a strong place and
about five stadia‡ away from Jerusalem,
he pressed it hard.
6 When Maccabaeus and his men
learned that he was besieging the
strongholds, they and all the people with
lamentations and tears made supplication
to the Lord to send a good angel to save
Israel.
7 Maccabaeus himself took up weapons
first, and exhorted the others to put
themselves in jeopardy together with him
and help their kindred; and they went out
with him very willingly.
8 As they were there, close to Jerusalem,
a horseman appeared at their head in
white apparel, brandishing§ weapons of
gold.
9 They all together praised the merciful
God, and were yet more strengthened in
heart, being ready to †assail not only men
but the wildest animals and walls of iron,
10 they advanced in array, having him
who is in heaven to fight on their side, for
the Lord had mercy on them.
11 Hurling themselves like lions against
the enemy, they killed eleven thousand
infantry and one thousand six hundred
cavalry, and forced all the rest to flee.
12 Most of them escaped wounded and
naked. Lysias himself also escaped by
shameful flight.
13 But as he was a man not void of
understanding, pondering the defeat
which had befallen him, and considering
that the Hebrews could not be overcome
because the Almighty God fought on their
side, he sent again
14 and persuaded them to come to terms
on condition that all their rights were
acknowledged, and ‡promised that he
would also persuade the king to become
their friend.
15 Maccabaeus gave consent upon all
the conditions which Lysias proposed to
him, being careful of the common good;
for whatever requests Maccabaeus
delivered in writing to Lysias concerning
the Jews the king allowed.

16 The letter written to the Jews from
Lysias was to this effect:

"Lysias to the §people of the Jews,
greetings.
17 John and Absalom, who were sent
from you, having delivered the document
written below, made request concerning
the things written therein.
18 Whatever things therefore needed to
be brought before the king I declared to
him, and what things were possible he
allowed.
19 If then you will all preserve your good
will toward the government, I will also
endeavor in the future to contribute to
your good.
20 Concerning this, I have given order in
detail, both to these men and to those who
are sent from me, to confer with you.

† **11:3** Or, *on all the sacred places of the heathen* ‡ **11:5** One stadia was roughly 189 meters or 618 feet, so 5 stadia was about a little less than 1 km or a little more than half a mile. § **11:8** Gr. *a panoply.* † **11:9** Gr. *wound.* ‡ **11:14** The Greek text here is corrupt. § **11:16** Gr. *multitude.* † **11:21** This month name is not found elsewhere, and is perhaps corrupt.

21 Farewell. Written in the one hundred
forty-eighth year, on the twenty-fourth
day of the month †Dioscorinthius."
22 And the king's letter contained these
words:
"King Antiochus to his brother Lysias,
greetings.
23 Seeing that our father passed to the
gods having the wish that the subjects of
his kingdom ‡should be undisturbed and
give themselves to the care of their own
affairs,
24 we, having heard that the Jews do not
consent to our father's purpose to turn
them to the customs of the Greeks, but
choose rather their own way of living, and
make request that the customs of their
law be allowed to them—
25 choosing therefore that this nation
also should be free from disturbance, we
determine that their temple is to be
restored to them, and that they live
according to the customs that were in the
days of their ancestors.
26 You will therefore do well to send
messengers to them and give them the
right hand of friendship, that they,
knowing our mind, may be of good heart,
and gladly occupy themselves with the
conduct of their own affairs."
27 And to the nation, the king's letter
was as follows:
"King Antiochus to the senate of the
Jews and to the other Jews, greetings.
28 If you are all well, it is as we desire.
We ourselves also are in good health.
29 Menelaus informed us that your
desire was to return home and follow
your own business.
30 They therefore who depart home up
to the thirtieth day of Xanthicus shall have
our §friendship, with full permission
31 that the Jews use their own foods and
observe their own laws, even as formerly.
None of them shall be in any way
molested for the things that have been
done in ignorance.
32 Moreover I have sent Menelaus also,
that he may encourage you.
33 Farewell. Written in the one hundred
forty-eighth year, on the fifteenth day of
Xanthicus."
34 The Romans also sent to them a letter
in these words:
"Quintus Memmius and Titus Manius,
ambassadors of the Romans, to the people
of the Jews, greetings.
35 In regard to the things which Lysias
the king's kinsman granted you, we also
give consent.
36 But as for the things which he judged
should be referred to the king, send
someone promptly, after you have
considered them, that we may publish
such decrees as are appropriate for your
case; for we are on our way to Antioch.
37 Therefore send someone with speed,
that we also may learn what is your mind.
38 †Farewell. Written in the one
hundred forty-eighth year, on the
fifteenth day of Xanthicus.

12

1 So when this agreement had been
made, Lysias departed to the king, and the
Jews went about their farming.
2 But some of the governors of districts,
Timotheus and Apollonius the son of
Gennaeus, and also Hieronymus and
Demophon, and beside them Nicanor the
governor of Cyprus, would not allow them
to enjoy tranquillity and live in peace.
3 Men of Joppa perpetrated this great
impiety: they invited the Jews who lived
among them to go with their wives and
children into the boats which they had
provided, as though they had no ill will
toward them.
4 When† the Jews,‡ relying on the public
vote of the city, accepted the invitation, as
men desiring to live in peace and
suspecting nothing, they took them out to
sea and drowned not less than two
hundred of them.
5 When Judas heard of the cruelty done
to his fellow-countrymen, giving
command to the men that were with him
6 and calling upon God the righteous
Judge, he came against the murderers of

‡ **11:23** Or, *should not be disquieted but also.* § **11:30** Gr. *right hand.* † **11:38** Gr. *Be in good health.* † **12:4** Gr. *they* ‡ **12:4** Gr. *after.*

his kindred, and set the harbor on fire at night, burned the boats, and put to the sword those who had fled there.
7 But when the town gates were closed, he withdrew, intending to come again to root out the whole community of the men of Joppa.
8 But learning that the men of Jamnia intended to do the same thing to the Jews who lived among them,
9 he attacked the Jamnites at night, and set fire to the harbor together with the fleet, so that the glare of the light was seen at Jerusalem, two hundred forty furlongs§ distant.
10 Now when they had drawn off nine furlongs† from there, as they marched against Timotheus, an army of Arabians attacked him, no fewer than five thousand infantry and five hundred cavalry.
11 And when a hard battle had been fought, and Judas and his company, by the help of God, had good success, the nomads being overcome implored Judas to grant them friendship, promising to give him livestock, and to help ‡his people in all other ways.
12 So Judas, thinking that they would indeed be profitable in many things, agreed to live in peace with them; and receiving pledges of friendship they departed to their tents.
13 He also attacked a certain city, strong and fenced with earthworks and walls, and inhabited by a mixed multitude of various nations. It was named Caspin.
14 Those who were within, trusting in the strength of the walls and their store of provisions, behaved themselves rudely toward Judas and those who were with him, railing, and furthermore blaspheming and speaking impious words.
15 But Judas and his company, calling upon the great Sovereign of the world, who without rams and cunning engines of war hurled down Jericho in the times of Joshua, rushed wildly against the wall.
16 Having taken the city by the will of God, they made unspeakable slaughter, so much that the adjoining lake, which was two furlongs§ broad, appeared to be filled with the deluge of blood.
17 When they had gone seven hundred fifty furlongs† from there, they made their way to Charax, to the Jews that are called ‡Tubieni.
18 They didn't find Timotheus in that district, for he had by then departed from the district without accomplishing anything, but had left behind a very strong garrison in one place.
19 But Dositheus and Sosipater, who were captains under Maccabaeus, went out and destroyed those who had been left by Timotheus in the stronghold, more than ten thousand men.
20 Maccabaeus, arranging his own army in divisions, set §these two over the bands, and marched in haste against Timotheus, who had with him one hundred twenty thousand infantry and two thousand five hundred cavalry.
21 When Timotheus heard of the approach of Judas, he at once sent away the women and the children with the baggage into the fortress called †Carnion; for the place was hard to besiege and difficult of access by reason of the narrowness of the approaches on all sides.
22 When the band of Judas, who led the first division, appeared in sight, and when terror and fear came upon the enemy, because the manifestation of him who sees all things came upon them, they fled in every direction, carried this way and that, so that they were often injured by their own men, and pierced with the points of their own swords.
23 Judas continued the pursuit more

§ **12:9** a furlong is about 201 meters or 220 yards, so 240 furlongs is about 48 km. or 30 miles † **12:10** a furlong is about 201 meters or 220 yards, so 9 furlongs is about 1.8 km. or 1 1/8 miles ‡ **12:11** Gr. *them.* § **12:16** a furlong is about 201 meters or 220 yards, so 2 furlongs is about 402 meters or 1/4 mile † **12:17** a furlong is about 201 meters or 220 yards, so 750 furlongs is about 151 km. or 94 miles ‡ **12:17** That is, *men of Tob:* see Judges 11:3, 2 Samuel 10:6, and compare 1 Maccabees 5:13. § **12:20** Gr. *them.* † **12:21** Compare *Carnain,*1 Maccabees 5:26, 43, 44.

vigorously, putting the wicked wretches
to the sword, and he destroyed as many as
thirty thousand men.

24 Timotheus himself, falling in with the
company of Dositheus and Sosipater,
implored them with much crafty guile to
let him go with his life, because he had in
his power the parents of many of them
and the kindred of some. ‡"Otherwise, he
said, little regard will §be shown to these."
25 So when he had with many words
confirmed the agreement to restore them
without harm, they let him go that they
might save their kindred.

26 Then Judas, marching against
†Carnion and the temple of Atergatis,
killed twenty-five thousand people.
27 After he had put these to flight and
destroyed them, he marched against
Ephron also, a strong city, ‡wherein were
multitudes of people of all nations.
Stalwart young men placed §on the walls
made a vigorous defense. There were
great stores of war engines and darts
there.
28 But calling upon the Sovereign who
with might shatters the †strength of ‡the
enemy, they took the city into their hands,
and killed as many as twenty-five
thousand of those who were in it.
29 Setting out from there, they marched
in haste against Scythopolis, which is six
hundred furlongs§ away from Jerusalem.
30 But when the Jews who were settled
there testified of the good will that the
Scythopolitans had shown toward them,
and of their kind treatment of them in the
times of their misfortune,
31 they gave thanks, and further
exhorted them to remain well disposed
toward the race for the future. Then they
went up to Jerusalem, the feast of weeks
being close at hand.

32 But after the feast called Pentecost,
they marched in haste against Gorgias the
governor of Idumaea.
33 He came out with three thousand
infantry and four hundred cavalry.
34 When they had set themselves in
array, it came to pass that a few of the
Jews fell.
35 A certain Dositheus, one †of Bacenor's
company, who was on horseback and was
a strong man, pressed hard on Gorgias,
and taking hold of his cloke dragged him
along by main force. While he planned to
take the accursed man alive, one of the
Thracian cavalry bore down on him and
disabled his shoulder, and so Gorgias
escaped to ‡Marisa.
36 When those who were with Esdris
had been fighting long and were weary,
Judas called upon the Lord to show
himself, fighting on their side and leading
in the battle.
37 Then in the language of his ancestors
he raised the battle cry joined with
hymns. Then he rushed against Gorgias'
troops when they were not expecting it,
and put them to flight.
38 Judas gathered his army and came to
the city of §Adullam. As the seventh day
was coming on, they purified themselves
according to the custom, and kept the
Sabbath there.
39 On the following day, †when it had
become necessary, Judas and his
company came to take up the bodies of
those who had fallen, ‡and in company
with their kinsmen to bring them back to
the sepulchres of their ancestors.
40 But under the garments of each one
of the dead they found §consecrated
tokens of the idols of Jamnia, which the
law forbids the Jews to have anything to
do with. It became clear to all that it was
for this cause that they had fallen.

---

‡ **12:24** Gr. *and the result will be that these be disregarded.* The Greek text here is perhaps corrupt. § **12:24** Or, *have been shown* † **12:26** Compare *Carnain,* 1 Maccabees 5:26, 43, 44. ‡ **12:27** The Greek text here is perhaps corrupt. § **12:27** Gr. *in front of.* † **12:28** Some authorities read *weight.* ‡ **12:28** Or, *his enemies* § **12:29** a furlong is about 201 meters or 220 yards, so 600 furlongs is about 121 km. or 75 miles † **12:35** The Greek text is uncertain. ‡ **12:35** Compare 1 Maccabees 5:65. § **12:38** Gr. *Odollam.* † **12:39** The Greek text here is uncertain. ‡ **12:39** Or, *and to bring them back to be with their kinsmen in the sepulchres* § **12:40** Perhaps these were consecrated images of the idols.

41 All therefore, blessing the ways of the
Lord, the righteous Judge, who makes
manifest the things that are hidden,
42 turned themselves to supplication,
praying that the sin committed might be
wholly blotted out. The noble Judas
exhorted the multitude to keep
themselves from sin, for they had seen
with their own eyes what happened
because of the sin of those who had fallen.
43 When he had made a collection man
by man to the sum of two thousand
drachmas of silver, he sent to Jerusalem to
offer a sacrifice for sin, doing very well
and honorably in this, in that he took
thought for the resurrection.
44 For if he wasn't expecting that those
who had fallen would rise again, it would
be superfluous and idle to pray for the
dead.
45 But if he was looking forward to an
honorable memorial of gratitude laid up
for those who †die ‡in godliness, then the
thought was holy and godly. Therefore he
made the atoning sacrifice for those who
had died, that they might be released
from their sin.

13

1 In the one hundred forty-ninth year,
news was brought to Judas and his
company that Antiochus Eupator was
coming with multitudes against Judea,
2 and with him Lysias his guardian and
chancellor, each having a Greek force of
one hundred ten thousand infantry, five
thousand three hundred cavalry,
twenty-two elephants, and three hundred
chariots armed with scythes.
3 And Menelaus also joined himself with
them, and with great hypocrisy
encouraged Antiochus, not for the saving
of his country, but because he thought
that he would be set over the government.
4 But the King of kings stirred up the
anger of Antiochus against the wicked
wretch. When Lysias informed him that
this man was the cause of all the evils, the
king commanded to bring him to Beroea,
and to put him to death in the way
customary in that place.
5 Now there is in that place a tower that
is fifty cubits high, full of ashes, and it had
all around it a †circular rim sloping
steeply on every side into the ashes.
6 Here one who is guilty of sacrilege or
notorious for other crimes is pushed
down to destruction.
7 By such a fate it happened that the
breaker of the law, Menelaus, died,
without obtaining so much as a grave in
the earth, and that justly;
8 for inasmuch as he had perpetrated
many sins ‡against the altar, whose fire
and whose ashes were holy, he received
his death in ashes.
9 Now the king,§ infuriated in spirit,
was coming with intent to inflict on the
Jews the very worst of the sufferings that
had been done in his father's time.
10 But when Judas heard of these things,
he commanded the multitude to call upon
the Lord day and night, if ever at any
other time, so now to help those who were
at the point of being deprived of the law,
their country, and the holy temple,
11 and not to allow the people who had
just begun to be revived to fall into the
hands of those profane heathen.
12 So when they had all done the same
thing together, †begging the merciful Lord
with weeping and fastings and
prostration for three days without
ceasing, Judas exhorted them and
commanded they should join him.
13 Having consulted privately with the
elders, he resolved that before the king's
army entered into Judea and made
themselves masters of the city, they
should go out and decide the matter by
the help of ‡God.
14 And committing the decision to the
§Lord of the world, and exhorting those
who were with him to contend nobly even
to death for laws, temple, city, country,

† **12:45** Gr. *fall asleep.* ‡ **12:45** Or, *on the side of godliness* † **13:5** Gr. *contrivance or machine.* ‡ **13:8** Gr. *about.*
§ **13:9** Some authorities read *indignant.* † **13:12** Gr. *and implored.* ‡ **13:13** Some authorities read *the Lord.*
§ **13:14** Some authorities read *Creator.*

and way of life, he pitched his camp by Modin.
15 He gave out to his men the watchword, “VICTORY IS GOD’S”, with a chosen force of the bravest young men he attacked by the king’s pavilion by night, and killed of his army as many as two thousand men, and †brought down the leading elephant with him who was in the ‡tower on him.
16 At last they filled the §army with terror and alarm, and departed with good success.
17 This had been accomplished when the day was just dawning, because of the Lord’s protection that gave †Judas help.
18 But the king, having had a taste of the exceeding boldness of the Jews, made strategic attacks on their positions,
19 and on a strong fortress of the Jews at Bethsura. He advanced, was turned back, failed, and was defeated.
20 Judas sent the things that were necessary to those who were within.
21 But Rhodocus, from the Jewish ranks, made secrets known to the enemy. He was sought out, arrested, and shut up in prison.
22 The king negotiated with them in Bethsura the second time, gave his hand, took theirs, departed, attacked the forces of Judas, was put to the worse,
23 heard that Philip who had been left as chancellor in Antioch had become reckless, was confounded, made to the Jews an overture of peace, submitted himself and swore to acknowledge all their rights, came to terms with them and offered sacrifice, honored the sanctuary and the place,
24 showed kindness and graciously received Maccabaeus, left Hegemonides governor from Ptolemais even to the ‡Gerrenians,
25 and came to Ptolemais. The men of Ptolemais were displeased at the treaty, for they had exceedingly great indignation against the Jews. They desired to annul the articles of the agreement.
26 Lysias §came forward to speak, made the best defense that was possible, persuaded, pacified, gained their good will, and departed to Antioch. This was the issue of the attack and departure of the king.

14

1 Three years later, news was brought to Judas and his company that Demetrius the son of Seleucus, having sailed into the harbor of Tripolis with a mighty army and a fleet,
2 had taken possession of the country, having made away with Antiochus and his guardian Lysias.
3 But one Alcimus, who had formerly been high priest, and had willfully polluted himself in the times when there was no mingling with the Gentiles, considering that there was no deliverance for him in any way, nor any more access to the holy altar,
4 came to King Demetrius in about the one hundred fifty-first year, presenting to him a crown of gold and a palm, and beside these some of the festal olive boughs of the temple. For that day, he held his peace;
5 but having gotten opportunity to further his own madness, being called by Demetrius into a meeting of his council, and asked how the Jews stood affected and what they intended, he answered:
6 “Those of the Jews called †Hasidaeans, whose leader is Judas Maccabaeus, keep up war and are seditious, not allowing the kingdom to find tranquillity.
7 Therefore, having laid aside my ancestral glory—I mean the high priesthood—I have now come ‡here,
8 first for the genuine care I have for the things that concern the king, and secondly because I have regard also to my own fellow citizens. For through the unadvised

† **13:15** The Greek text here is probably corrupt. ‡ **13:15** Gr. *house.* § **13:16** Gr. *camp.* † **13:17** Gr. *him.* ‡ **13:24** The form of this word is uncertain. Compare *Girzites* (or *Gizrites),* 1 Samuel 27:8. One manuscript reads *Gerarenes.* § **13:26** Gr. *came forward to the tribune* or *judgment seat.* † **14:6** That is, *Chasidim.* ‡ **14:7** Some authorities read *a second time.*

dealing of those of whom I spoke before,
our whole race is in no small misfortune.
9 O king, having informed yourself of
these things, take thought both for our
country and for our race, which is
surrounded by enemies, according to the
gracious kindness with which you receive
all.
10 For as long as Judas remains alive, it
is impossible for the government to find
peace.
11 When he had spoken such words as
these, at once §the rest of the king's
†friends, having ill will against Judas,
inflamed Demetrius yet more.
12 He immediately appointed Nicanor,
who had been master of the elephants,
and made him governor of Judea. He sent
him out,
13 giving him written instructions to kill
Judas himself and to scatter those who
were with him, and to set up Alcimus as
high priest of the ‡great temple.
14 Those in Judea who §had driven
Judas into exile thronged to Nicanor in
flocks, supposing that the misfortunes
and calamities of the Jews would be
successes to themselves.
15 But when the Jews heard of Nicanor's
advance and the assault of the heathen,
they sprinkled dirt on their heads and
made solemn prayers to him who had
established his own people for evermore,
and who always, making manifest his
presence, upholds those who are his own
heritage.
16 †When the leader had given orders,
he immediately set out from there and
joined battle with them at a village called
Lessau.
17 But Simon, the brother of Judas, had
encountered Nicanor, yet not till late,
having been delayed by reason of the
sudden consternation caused by his
adversaries.
18 Nevertheless Nicanor, hearing of the
valor of those who were with Judas, and
their courage in fighting for their country,
shrank from bringing the matter to the
decision of the sword.
19 Therefore he sent Posidonius,
Theodotus, and Mattathias to give and
receive pledges of friendship.
20 So when these proposals had been
long considered, and the leader had made
the ‡troops acquainted with them, and it
appeared that they were all of like mind,
they consented to the covenants.
21 They appointed a day on which to
meet together by themselves. A chariot
came forward from each army. They set
up seats of honor.
22 Judas stationed armed men ready in
convenient places, lest perhaps there
should suddenly be treachery on the part
of the enemy. They held a conference as
was appropriate.
23 Nicanor waited in Jerusalem, and did
nothing to cause disturbance, but
dismissed the flocks of people that had
gathered together.
24 He kept Judas always in his presence.
He had gained a hearty affection for the
man.
25 He urged him to marry and have
children. He married, settled quietly, and
took part in common life.

26 But Alcimus, perceiving the good will
that was between them, §and having
taken possession of the covenants that
had been made, came to Demetrius and
told him that Nicanor was disloyal to the
government, for he had appointed that
conspirator against his kingdom, Judas, to
be his successor.
27 The king, falling into a rage, and
being exasperated by the false
accusations of that most wicked man,
wrote to Nicanor, signifying that he was
displeased at the covenants, and
commanding him to send Maccabaeus
prisoner to Antioch in all haste.
28 When this message came to Nicanor,
he was confounded, and was very
troubled at the thought of annulling the

§ **14:11** Or, *the* king's *friends likewise* † **14:11** See 2 Maccabees 8:9. ‡ **14:13** Gr. *greatest.* § **14:14** See 2 Maccabees 5:27. † **14:16** The Greek text of this verse and the next is corrupt. ‡ **14:20** Or, *people* Gr. *multitudes.* § **14:26** Or, *and the covenants that had been made, took occasion and came*

articles that had been agreed upon, the man having done no wrong;
29 but because there was no opposing the king, he watched his time to execute this purpose by strategy.
30 But Maccabaeus, when he perceived that Nicanor was behaving more harshly in his dealings with him, and that he had become ruler in his customary bearing, understanding that this harshness came not of good, gathered together not a few of his men, and concealed himself from Nicanor.
31 But the other,† when he became aware that he had been bravely defeated by the strategy of Judas,‡ came to the great§ and holy temple, while the priests were offering the usual sacrifices, and commanded them to hand over the man.
32 When they declared with oaths that they had no knowledge where the man was whom he sought,
33 he stretched out his right hand toward the sanctuary, and swore this oath: "If you won't deliver up to me Judas as a prisoner, I will level this †temple of God even with the ground, break down the altar, and I will erect here a temple to Dionysus for all to see.
34 And having said this, he departed. But the priests, stretching forth their hands toward heaven, called upon him who always fights for our nation, in these words:
35 "You, O Lord of the universe, who in yourself have need of nothing, were well pleased that a sanctuary of your habitation‡ should be set among us.
36 So now, O holy Lord of all holiness, keep undefiled forever this house that has been recently cleansed."
37 Now information was given to Nicanor against one Razis, an elder of Jerusalem, who was a lover of his countrymen and a man of very good report, and one called Father of the Jews for his good will.
38 For in the former times when there was no mingling with the Gentiles, he had been accused of following the Jews' religion, and had risked body and life with all earnestness for the religion of the Jews.
39 Nicanor, wishing to make evident the ill will that he bore against the Jews, sent above five hundred soldiers to seize him;
40 for he thought by seizing him to inflict an injury on them.
41 But when the §troops were at the point of taking the tower, and were forcing the door of the court, and asked for fire to burn the doors, he, being surrounded on every side, fell upon his sword,
42 choosing rather to die nobly than to fall into the hands of the wicked wretches, and suffer outrage unworthy of his own nobleness.
43 But since he missed his stroke through the excitement of the struggle, and the crowds were now rushing within the door, he ran bravely up to the wall and cast himself down bravely among the crowds.
44 But as they quickly gave back, a space was made, and he fell on the middle of †his side.
45 Still having breath within him, and being inflamed with anger, he rose up, and though his blood gushed out in streams and his wounds were grievous, he ran through the crowds, and standing upon a steep rock,
46 when as his blood was now well near spent, he drew forth his bowels through the wound, and taking them in both his hands he shook them at the crowds. Calling upon him who is Lord of life and spirit to restore him ‡these again, he died like this.

15

1 But Nicanor, hearing that Judas and his company were in the region of Samaria, resolved to attack them with complete safety on the day of rest.

† **14:31** Or, *though he was conscious that he had been nobly defeated by* ‡ **14:31** Gr. *the man* § **14:31** Gr. *greatest.*
† **14:33** Or, *chapel* Gr. *enclosure.* ‡ **14:35** Gr. *tabernacling.* § **14:41** Or, *people* Gr. *multitudes.* † **14:44** Or, *the void place* ‡ **14:46** Some authorities read *the same.*

2 When the Jews who were compelled to
follow him said, “Don’t destroy so
savagely and barbarously, but give due
glory to the day which he who sees all
things has honored and hallowed above
other days.”
3 Then the thrice-accursed wretch asked
if there were a Sovereign in heaven who
had commanded to keep the Sabbath day.
4 When they declared, “There is the
Lord, living himself as Sovereign in
heaven, who told us observe the seventh
day.”
5 He replied, “I also am a sovereign on
the earth, who commands you to take up
weapons and execute the king’s business.”
Nevertheless he didn’t prevail to execute
his cruel plan.
6 And Nicanor, †in his utter boastfulness
and arrogance, had determined to set up a
monument of complete victory over Judas
and all those who were with him.
7 But Maccabaeus still trusted
unceasingly, with all hope that he should
obtain help from the Lord.
8 He exhorted his company not to be
fearful at the assault of the heathen, but
keeping in mind the help which in former
times they had often received from
heaven, so now also to look for the victory
which would come to them from the
Almighty,
9 and encouraging them out of the law
and the prophets, and reminding them of
the conflicts that they had won, he made
them more eager.
10 And when he had aroused their
courage, he gave them orders, at the same
time pointing out the faithlessness of the
heathen and their breach of their oaths.
11 Arming each one of them, not so
much with the sure defense of shields and
spears as with the encouragement of good
words, and moreover relating to them a
dream worthy to be believed, he made
them all exceedingly glad.
12 The vision of that dream was this:
Onias, he who had been high priest, a
noble and good man, modest in bearing,
yet gentle in manner and well-spoken,
and trained from a child in all points of
virtue, with outstretched hands invoking
blessings on the whole body of the Jews.
13 Then he saw a man appear, of
venerable age and exceeding glory, and
the dignity around him was wonderful
and most majestic.
14 Onias answered and said, “This is the
lover of the kindred, he who prays much
for the people and the holy city: Jeremiah
the prophet of God.
15 Jeremiah stretched out his right hand
and delivered to Judas a gold sword, and
in giving it addressed him thus:
16 “Take this holy sword, a gift from God,
with which you shall strike down the
adversaries.”
17 Being encouraged by the words of
Judas, which were noble and effective,
and able to incite to virtue and to stir the
souls of the young to manly courage, they
determined not to carry on a campaign,
but nobly to bear down upon the enemy,
and fighting hand to hand with all
courage bring the matter to a conclusion,
because the city, the sanctuary, and the
temple were in danger.
18 For their fear for wives and children,
and furthermore for family and relatives,
was less important to them; but greatest
and first was their fear for the
consecrated sanctuary.
19 Also those who were shut up in the
city were in no light distress, being
troubled because of the encounter in the
open country.
20 When all were now waiting for the
decision of the issue, and the enemy had
already joined battle, and the army had
been set in array, and the elephants‡
brought back to a convenient post,§ and
the cavalry deployed on the flanks,
21 Maccabaeus, perceiving the presence
of the †troops, and the various weapons
with which they were equipped, and the
savageness of the ‡elephants, holding up
his hands to heaven called upon the Lord
who works wonders, knowing that
success comes not by weapons, but that,

† **15:6** Gr. *carrying his neck high.* ‡ **15:20** Gr. *animals.* § **15:20** Or, *stationed for convenient action* † **15:21** Gr. *multitudes.* ‡ **15:21** Gr. *animals.*

according to how the Lord judges, he
gains the victory for those who are
worthy.
22 And calling upon God, he said this:
"You, O Sovereign Lord, sent your angel in
the time of King Hezekiah of Judea, and he
killed of the §army of Sennacherib as
many as one hundred eighty-five
thousand.
23 So now also, O Sovereign of the
heavens, send a good angel before us to
bring terror and trembling.
24 Through the greatness of your arm let
them be stricken with dismay who with
blasphemy have come here against your
holy people." As he finished these words,
25 Nicanor and his company advanced
with trumpets and victory songs;
26 but Judas and his company joined
battle with the enemy with invocation
and prayers.
27 Fighting with their hands and praying
to God with their hearts, they killed no
less than thirty-five thousand men, being
made exceedingly glad by the
manifestation of God.
28 When the engagement was over and
they were returning again with joy, they
recognized Nicanor lying dead in full
armor.
29 Then there was shouting and noise,
and they blessed the Sovereign Lord in
the language of their ancestors.
30 He who in all things was in body and
soul the foremost champion of his
fellow-citizens, he who kept through life
the good will of his youth toward his
countrymen, ordered that Nicanor's head
be cut off with his hand and arm, and that
they be brought to Jerusalem.
31 When he had arrived there and had
called his countrymen together and set
the priests before the altar, he sent for
those who were in the citadel.
32 Showing the head of the vile Nicanor
and the hand of that profane man, which
with proud brags he had stretched out
against the holy house of the Almighty,
33 and cutting out the tongue of the
impious Nicanor, he said that he would
give it in pieces to the birds, and hang up
these rewards of his folly near the
sanctuary.
34 They all, looking up to heaven,
blessed the Lord who had manifested
himself, saying, "Blessed is he who has
preserved his own place undefiled!"
35 He hung Nicanor's head and shoulder
from the citadel, a clear sign evident to all
of the help of the Lord.
36 They all ordained with a common
decree to in no way let this day pass
undistinguished, but to mark with honor
the thirteenth day of the twelfth month (it
is called Adar in the Syrian language), the
day before the day of Mordecai.

37 This then having been the account of
the attempt of Nicanor, and the city
having from those times been held by the
Hebrews, I also will here make an end of
my book.
38 If I have written well and to the point
in my story, this is what I myself desired;
but if its poorly done and mediocre, this is
the best I could do.
39 For as it is †distasteful to drink wine
alone and likewise to drink water alone,
‡while the mingling of wine with water at
once gives full pleasantness to the flavor;
so also the fashioning of the language
delights the ears of those who read the
story.
Here is the end.

§ **15:22** Gr. *camp.* † **15:39** Or, *hurtful* ‡ **15:39** Gr. *but even as.*

The First Book of Esdras

The First Book of Esdras is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Greek Orthodox and Russian Orthodox Churches. It is not recognized by the Roman Catholic Church, but 1 Esdras is placed as an appendix to the Latin Vulgate Bible.

1 *Josias held the Passover in Jerusalem
to his Lord, and offered the Passover the
fourteenth day of the first month,
2 having set the priests according to
their daily courses, being arrayed in their
vestments, in the Lord's temple.
3 He spoke to the Levites, *the temple
servants of Israel, that they should make
themselves holy to the Lord, to set the
holy ark of the Lord in the house that King
Solomon the son of David had built.
4 He said, "You no longer need to carry it
on your shoulders. Now therefore serve
the Lord your God, and minister to his
people Israel, and prepare yourselves by
your fathers' houses and kindred,
5 according to the writing of King David
of Israel, and according to the
magnificence of Solomon his son. Stand in
the holy place according to the divisions
of your Levite families who minister in
the presence of your kindred the
descendants of Israel.
6 Offer the Passover in order, prepare
the sacrifices for your kindred, and keep
the Passover according to the Lord's
commandment, which was given to
Moses.
7 To the people which were present,
Josias gave thirty thousand lambs and
kids, and three thousand calves. These
things were given from the king's
possessions, as he promised, to the people
and to the priests and Levites.
8 Helkias, Zacharias, and †Esyelus, the
rulers of the temple, gave to the priests for
the Passover two thousand six hundred
sheep, and three hundred calves.
9 Jeconias, Samaias, Nathanael his
brother, Sabias, Ochielus, and Joram,
captains over thousands, gave to the
Levites for the Passover five thousand
sheep and seven hundred calves.
10 When these things were done, the
priests and Levites, having the
unleavened bread, stood in proper order
according to the kindred,
11 and according to the several divisions
by fathers' houses, before the people, to
offer to the Lord as it is written in the book
of Moses. They did this in the morning.
12 They roasted the Passover lamb with
fire, as required. They boiled the
sacrifices in the brazen vessels and
caldrons with a pleasing smell,
13 and set them before all the people.
Afterward they prepared for themselves
and for their kindred the priests, the sons
of Aaron.
14 For the priests offered the fat until
night. The Levites prepared for
themselves and for their kindred the
priests, the sons of Aaron.
15 The holy singers also, the sons of
Asaph, were in their order, according to
the appointment of David: Asaph,
Zacharias, and Eddinus, who represented
the king.
16 Moreover the gatekeepers were at
every gate. No one needed to depart from
his daily duties, for their kindred the
Levites prepared for them.
17 So the things that belonged to the
Lord's sacrifices were accomplished in
that day, in holding the Passover,
18 and offering sacrifices on the altar of
the Lord, according to the commandment
of King Josias.
19 So the children of Israel which were
present at that time held the Passover and
the feast of unleavened bread seven days.
20 Such a Passover had not been held in
Israel since the time of the prophet
Samuel.
21 Indeed, none of the kings of Israel
held such a Passover as Josias with the
priests, the Levites, and the Jews, held

* **1:1** 2 Kings 23:21; 2 Chronicles 35:1 * **1:3** Numbers 3:9 † **1:8** *Jehiel,* 2 Chronicles 35:8.

with all Israel that were present in their dwelling place at Jerusalem.
22 This Passover was held in the eighteenth year of the reign of Josias.
23 The works of Josias were upright before his Lord with a heart full of godliness.
24 Moreover the things that came to pass in his days have been written in times past, concerning those who sinned and did wickedly against the Lord more than any other people or kingdom, and how they grieved him ‡exceedingly, so that the Lord's words were confirmed against Israel.

25 *Now after all these acts of Josias, it came to pass that Pharaoh the king of Egypt came to make war at Carchemish on the Euphrates; and Josias went out against him.
26 But the king of Egypt sent to him, saying, "What do I have to do with you, O king of Judea?
27 I wasn't sent out from the Lord God against you, for my war is against the Euphrates. Now the Lord is with me, yes, the Lord is with me hastening me forward. Depart from me, and don't be against the Lord."

28 However, Josias didn't turn back to his chariot, but tried to fight with him, not regarding the words of the prophet Jeremy from the Lord's mouth,
29 but joined battle with him in the plain of Megiddo, and the commanders came down against King Josias.
30 Then the king said to his servants, "Carry me away out of the battle, for I am very weak!" Immediately his servants carried him away out of the army.
31 Then he got into his second chariot. After he was brought back to Jerusalem he died, and was buried in the tomb of his ancestors.
32 All Judea mourned for Josias. Jeremy the prophet lamented for Josias, and the chief men with the women made lamentation for him to this day. This was given out for an ordinance to be done continually in all the nation of Israel.
33 These things are written in the book of the histories of the kings of Judea, and every one of the acts that Josias did, and his glory, and his understanding in the law of the Lord, and the things that he had done before, and the things now told, are reported in the book of the kings of Israel and Judah.

34 *The people took §Joachaz the son of Josias, and made him king instead of Josias his father, when he was twenty-three years old.
35 He reigned in Judah and Jerusalem for three months. Then the king of Egypt deposed him from reigning in Jerusalem.
36 He set a tax upon the people of one hundred talents of silver and one talent of gold.
37 The king of Egypt also made King Joakim his brother king of Judea and Jerusalem.
38 And Joakim imprisoned the nobles and apprehended his brother Zarakes, and brought him up out of Egypt.

39 *Joakim was twenty-five years old when he began to reign in Judea and Jerusalem. He did that which was evil in the sight of the Lord.
40 King Nabuchodonosor of Babylon came up against him, bound him with a chain of brass, and carried him to Babylon.
41 Nabuchodonosor also took some of the Lord's holy vessels, carried them away, and stored them in his own temple at Babylon.
42 But those things that are reported of him, and of his uncleanness and impiety, are written in the chronicles of the kings.
43 Then Joakim his son reigned in his place. When he was made king, he was eighteen years old.
44 He reigned three months and ten days in Jerusalem. He did that which was evil before the Lord.

‡ **1:24** Or, *sensibly* Judges 16:17. * **1:25** 2 Chronicles 35:20 * **1:34** 2 Kings 23:30; 2 Chronicles 36:1 § **1:34** Another reading is, *Jeconias.* * **1:39** 2 Chronicles 36:4-5

45 So after a year Nabuchodonosor sent and caused him to be brought to Babylon with the holy vessels of the Lord,
46 and made Sedekias king of Judea and Jerusalem when he was twenty-one years old. He reigned eleven years.
47 He also did that which was evil in the sight of the Lord, and didn't heed the words that were spoken by Jeremy the prophet from the Lord's mouth.
48 After King Nabuchodonosor had made him to swear by the name of the Lord, he broke his oath and rebelled. Hardening his neck and his heart, he transgressed the laws of the Lord, the God of Israel.
49 Moreover the governors of the people and of the priests did many things wickedly, exceeding all the defilements of all nations, and defiled the temple of the Lord, which was sanctified in Jerusalem.
50 The God of their ancestors sent by his messenger to call them back, because he had compassion on them and on his dwelling place.
51 But they mocked his messengers. In the day when the Lord spoke, they scoffed at his prophets
52 until he, being angry with his people for their great ungodliness, commanded to bring up the kings of the Chaldeans against them.
53 They killed their young men with the sword around their holy temple, and spared neither young man or young woman, old man or child; but he delivered all of them into their hands.
54 They took all the holy vessels of the Lord, both great and small, with the treasure chests of the Lord's ark and the king's treasures, and carried them away to Babylon.
55 They burned the Lord's house, broke down Jerusalem's walls, and burned its towers with fire.
56 As for her glorious things, they didn't stop until they had brought them all to nothing. He carried the people who weren't slain with the sword to Babylon.
57 They were servants to him and to his children until the Persians reigned, to fulfill the word of the Lord by the mouth of Jeremy:
58 "Until the land has enjoyed its Sabbaths, the whole time of her desolation shall she keep Sabbath, to fulfill seventy years.

2

1 In the *first year of King Cyrus of the Persians, that the word of the Lord by the mouth of Jeremy might be accomplished,
2 the Lord stirred up the spirit of King Cyrus of the Persians, and he made a proclamation throughout all his kingdom, and also by writing,
3 saying, "Cyrus king of the Persians says: The Lord of Israel, the Most High Lord, has made me king of the whole world,
4 and commanded me to build him a house at Jerusalem that is in Judea.
5 If therefore there are any of you that are of his people, let the Lord, even his Lord, be with him, and let him go up to Jerusalem that is in Judea, and build the house of the Lord of Israel. He is the Lord who dwells in Jerusalem.
6 Therefore, of those who dwell in various places, let those who are in his own place each help with gold, with silver,
7 with gifts, with horses, and cattle, beside the other things which have been added by vow for the temple of the Lord which is in Jerusalem.

8 Then the chief of the families of Judah and of the tribe of Benjamin stood up, with the priests, the Levites, and all whose spirit the Lord had stirred to go up, to build the house for the Lord which is in Jerusalem.
9 Those who lived around them helped them in all things with silver and gold, with horses and cattle, and with very many gifts that were vowed by a great number whose minds were so moved.
10 King Cyrus also brought out the holy vessels of the Lord, which Nabuchodonosor had carried away from

* **2:1** 2 Chronicles 36:22,23; Ezra 1:1

Jerusalem and had stored in his temple of idols.
11 Now when King Cyrus of the Persians had brought them out, he delivered them to Mithradates his treasurer,
12 and by him they were delivered to †Sanabassar the governor of Judea.
13 This was the number of them: one thousand gold cups, one thousand silver cups, twenty-nine silver censers, thirty gold bowls, two thousand four hundred ten silver bowls, and one thousand other vessels.
14 So all the vessels of gold and of silver were brought up, even five thousand four hundred seventy-nine,
15 and were carried back by Sanabassar, together with the returning exiles, from Babylon to Jerusalem.

16 *In the time of King Artaxerxes of the Persians, Belemus, Mithradates, Tabellius, ‡Rathumus, Beeltethmus, and §Samellius the scribe, with their other associates, dwelling in Samaria and other places, wrote to him against those who lived in Judea and Jerusalem the following letter:

17 "To King Artaxerxes our Lord, from your servants, Rathumus the recorder, Samellius the scribe, and the rest of their council, and the judges who are in Coelesyria and Phoenicia:
18 Let it now be known to our lord the king, that the Jews that have come up from you to us, having come to Jerusalem, are building that rebellious and wicked city, and are repairing its marketplaces and walls, and are laying the foundation of a temple.
19 Now if this city is built and its walls are finished, they will not only refuse to give tribute, but will even stand up against kings.
20 Since the things pertaining to the temple are now in hand, we think it appropriate not to neglect such a matter,
21 but to speak to our lord the king, to the intent that, if it is your pleasure, search may be made in the books of your ancestors.
22 You will find in the chronicles what is written concerning these things, and will understand that that city was rebellious, troubling both kings and cities,
23 and that the Jews were rebellious, and kept starting wars there in the past. For this cause, this city was laid waste.
24 Therefore now we do declare to you, O lord the king, that if this city is built again, and its walls set up again, you will from then on have no passage into Coelesyria and Phoenicia."
25 Then the king wrote back again to Rathumus the recorder, Beeltethmus, Samellius the scribe, and to the rest of their associates who lived in Samaria, Syria, and Phoenicia, as follows:
26 "I have read the letter which you have sent to me. Therefore I commanded to make search, and it has been found that that city of old time has fought against kings,
27 and the men were given to rebellion and war in it, and that mighty and fierce kings were in Jerusalem, who reigned and exacted tribute in Coelesyria and Phoenicia.
28 Now therefore I have commanded to prevent those men from building the city, and heed to be taken that there be nothing done contrary to this order,
29 and that those wicked doings proceed no further to the annoyance of kings."
30 Then King Artaxerxes, his letters being read, Rathumus, and Samellius the scribe, and the rest of their associates, went in haste to Jerusalem with cavalry and a multitude of people in battle array, and began to hinder the builders. So the building of the temple in Jerusalem ceased until the second year of the reign of King Darius of the Persians.

3

1 Now King Darius made a great feast for all his subjects, for all who were born in his house, for all the princes of Media and of Persia,
2 and for all the local governors and captains and governors who were under

† **2:12** Another reading is, *Simanassar.* * **2:16** Ezra 4:7 ‡ **2:16** *Rehum,* § **2:16** *Shimshai.*

him, from India to Ethiopia, in the one hundred twenty seven provinces.
3 They ate and drank, and when they were satisfied went home. Then King Darius went into his bedchamber and slept, but awakened out of his sleep.
4 Then the three young men of the bodyguard, who guarded the king, spoke one to another:
5 "Let every one of us state what one thing is strongest. King Darius will give him whose statement seems wiser than the others great gifts and great honors in token of victory.
6 He shall be clothed in purple, drink from gold cups, sleep on a gold bed, and have a chariot with bridles of gold, a fine linen turban, and a chain around his neck.
7 He shall sit next to Darius because of his wisdom, and shall be called cousin of Darius."
8 Then they each wrote his sentence, sealed them, and laid them under King Darius' pillow,
9 and said, "When the king wakes up, someone will give him the writing. Whoever the king and the three princes of Persia judge that his sentence is the wisest, to him shall the victory be given, as it is written."
10 The first wrote, "Wine is the strongest."
11 The second wrote, "The king is strongest."
12 The third wrote, "Women are strongest, but above all things Truth is the victor."
13 Now when the king woke up, they took the writing and gave it to him, so he read it.
14 Sending out, he called all the princes of Persia and of Media, the local governors, the captains, the governors, and the chief officers
15 and sat himself down in the royal seat of judgment; and the writing was read before them.
16 He said, "Call the young men, and they shall explain their own sentences. So they were called and came in.
17 They said to them, "Explain what you have written."

Then the first, who had spoken of the strength of wine, began
18 and said this: "O sirs, how exceedingly strong wine is! It causes all men who drink it to go astray.
19 It makes the mind of the king and of the fatherless child to be the same, likewise of the bondman and of the freeman, of the poor man and of the rich.
20 It also turns every thought into cheer and mirth, so that a man remembers neither sorrow nor debt.
21 It makes every heart rich, so that a man remembers neither king nor local governor. It makes people say things in large amounts.
22 When they are in their cups, they forget their love both to friends and kindred, and before long draw their swords.
23 But when they awake from their wine, they don't remember what they have done.
24 O sirs, isn't wine the strongest, seeing that it forces people to do this?" And when he had said this, he stopped speaking.

4

1 Then the second, who had spoken of the strength of the king, began to say,
2 "O sirs, don't men excel in strength who rule over the sea and land, and all things in them?
3 But yet the king is stronger. He is their lord and has dominion over them. In whatever he commands them, they obey him.
4 If he tells them to make war against each other, they do it. If he sends them out against the enemies, they go, and conquer mountains, walls, and towers.
5 They kill and are killed, and don't disobey the king's commandment. If they win the victory, they bring everything to the king—all the plunder and everything else.
6 Likewise for those who are not soldiers, and don't have anything to do with wars, but farm, when they have reaped again that which they had sown, they bring some to the king and compel one another to pay tribute to the king.

7 He is just one man! If he commands
people to kill, they kill. If he commands
them to spare, they spare.
8 If he commands them to strike, they
strike. If he commands them to make
desolate, they make desolate. If he
commands to build, they build.
9 If he commands them to cut down,
they cut down. If he commands them to
plant, they plant.
10 So all his people and his armies obey
him. Furthermore, he lies down, he eats
and drinks, and takes his rest;
11 and these keep watch around him.
None of them may depart and do his own
business. They don't disobey him in
anything.
12 O sirs, how could the king not be the
strongest, seeing that he is obeyed like
this?" Then he stopped talking.
13 Then the third, who had spoken of
women, and of truth, (this was Zorobabel)
began to speak:
14 "O sirs, isn't the king great, and men
are many, and isn't wine strong? Who is it
then who rules them, or has the lordship
over them? Aren't they women?
15 Women have given birth to the king
and all the people who rule over sea and
land.
16 They came from women. Women
nourished up those who planted the
vineyards, from where the wine comes.
17 Women also make garments for men.
These bring glory to men. Without
women, men can't exist.
18 Yes, and if men have gathered
together gold and silver and any other
beautiful thing, and see a woman who is
lovely in appearance and beauty,
19 they let all those things go and gape at
her, and with open mouth stare at her.
They all have more desire for her than for
gold, or silver, or any other beautiful
thing.
20 A man leaves his own father who
brought him up, leaves his own country,
and joins with his wife.
21 With his wife he ends his days, with
no thought for his father, mother, or
country.
22 By this also you must know that
women have dominion over you. Don't
you labor and toil, and bring it all to give
to women?
23 Yes, a man takes his sword and goes
out to travel, to rob, to steal, and to sail on
the sea and on rivers.
24 He sees a lion and walks in the
darkness. When he has stolen, plundered,
and robbed, he brings it to the woman he
loves.
25 Therefore a man loves his wife better
than father or mother.
26 Yes, there are many who have lost
their minds for women, and become
slaves for their sakes.
27 Many also have perished, have
stumbled, and sinned, for women.
28 Now don't you believe me? Isn't the
king great in his power? Don't all regions
fear to touch him?
29 Yet I saw him and Apame the king's
concubine, the daughter of the illustrious
Barticus, sitting at the right hand of the
king,
30 and taking the crown from the king's
head, and setting it upon her own head.
Yes, she struck the king with her left hand.
31 At this, the king gaped and gazed at
her with open mouth. If she smiles at him,
he laughs. But if she takes any displeasure
at him, he flatters her, that she might be
reconciled to him again.
32 O sirs, how can it not be that women
are strong, seeing they do this?"
33 Then the king and the nobles looked
at one another. So he began to speak
concerning truth.
34 "O sirs, aren't women strong? The
earth is great. The sky is high. The sun is
swift in its course, for it circles around the
sky, and returns on its course again in one
day.
35 Isn't he who makes these things
great? Therefore the truth is great, and
stronger than all things.
36 All the earth calls upon truth, and the
sky blesses truth. All works shake and
tremble, but with truth there is no
unrighteous thing.
37 Wine is unrighteous. The king is
unrighteous. Women are unrighteous. All

the children of men are unrighteous, and all their works are unrighteous. There is no truth in them. They shall also perish in their unrighteousness.
38 But truth remains, and is strong forever. Truth lives and conquers forevermore.
39 With truth there is no partiality toward persons or rewards, but truth does the things that are just, instead of any unrighteous or wicked things. All men approve truth's works.
40 In truth's judgment is not any unrighteousness. Truth is the strength, the kingdom, the power, and the majesty of all ages. Blessed be the God of truth!"
41 With that, he stopped speaking. Then all the people shouted and said, "Great is truth, and strong above all things!"
42 Then the king said to him, "Ask what you wish, even more than is appointed in writing, and we will give it to you, because you are found wisest. You shall sit next to me, and shall be called my cousin."
43 Then he said to the king, "Remember your vow, which you vowed to build Jerusalem, in the day when you came to your kingdom,
44 and to send back all the vessels that were taken out of Jerusalem, which Cyrus set apart when he vowed to destroy Babylon, and vowed to send them back there.
45 You also vowed to build the temple which the Edomites burned when Judea was made desolate by the Chaldeans.
46 Now, O lord the king, this is what I request, and what I desire of you, and this is the princely generosity that may proceed from you: I ask therefore that you make good the vow, the performance of which you have vowed to the King of Heaven with your own mouth."
47 Then King Darius stood up, kissed him, and wrote letters for him to all the treasurers and governors and captains and local governors, that they should safely bring on their way both him, and all those who would go up with him to build Jerusalem.
48 He wrote letters also to all the governors who were in Coelesyria and Phoenicia, and to them in Libanus, that they should bring cedar wood from Libanus to Jerusalem, and that they should help him build the city.
49 Moreover he wrote for all the Jews who would go out of his realm up into Judea concerning their freedom, that no officer, no governor, no local governor, nor treasurer, should forcibly enter into their doors,
50 and that all the country which they occupied should be free to them without tribute, and that the Edomites should give up the villages of the Jews which they held at that time,
51 and that there should be given twenty talents yearly toward the building of the temple, until the time that it was built,
52 and another ten talents yearly for burnt offerings to be presented upon the altar every day, as they had a commandment to make seventeen offerings,
53 and that all those who would come from Babylonia to build the city should have their freedom—they and their descendants, and all the priests that came.
54 He wrote also to give them their support and the priests' vestments in which they minister.
55 For the Levites he wrote that their support should be given them until the day that the house was finished and Jerusalem built up.
56 He commanded that land and wages should be given to all who guarded the city.
57 He also sent away all the vessels from Babylon that Cyrus had set apart, and all that Cyrus had given in commandment, he commanded also to be done and to be sent to Jerusalem.
58 Now when this young man had gone out, he lifted up his face to heaven toward Jerusalem, and praised the King of heaven,
59 and said, "From you comes victory. From you comes wisdom. Yours is the glory, and I am your servant.

60 Blessed are you, who have given me
wisdom. I give thanks to you, O Lord of
our fathers.
61 So he took the letters, went out, came
to Babylon, and told it to all his kindred.
62 They praised the God of their
ancestors, because he had given them
freedom and liberty
63 to go up and to build Jerusalem and
the temple which is called by his name.
They feasted with instruments of music
and gladness for seven days.

5

1 After this, the chiefs of fathers' houses
were chosen to go up according to their
tribes, with their wives, sons, and
daughters, with their menservants and
maidservants, and their livestock.
2 Darius sent with them one thousand
cavalry to bring them back to Jerusalem
with peace, with musical instruments,
drums, and flutes.
3 All their kindred were making merry,
and he made them go up together with
them.
4 These are the names of the men who
went up, according to their families
among their tribes, after their several
divisions.
5 The priests, the sons of Phinees, the
sons of Aaron: Jesus the son of Josedek,
the son of Saraias, and Joakim the son of
Zorobabel, the son of Salathiel, of the
house of David, of the lineage of Phares, of
the tribe of Judah,
6 who spoke wise words before Darius
the king of Persia in the second year of his
reign, in the month Nisan, which is the
first month.
7 *These are the of Judeans who came
up from the captivity, where they lived as
foreigners, whom Nabuchodonosor the
king of Babylon had carried away to
Babylon.
8 They returned to Jerusalem and to the
other parts of Judea, every man to his own
city, who came with Zorobabel, with
Jesus, Nehemias, †Zaraias, Resaias,‡
Eneneus, Mardocheus, Beelsarus,§
Aspharsus,† Reelias, Roimus, and Baana,
their leaders.
9 The number of them of the nation and
their leaders: the sons of Phoros, two
thousand one hundred seventy two; the
sons of‡ Saphat, four hundred seventy
two;
10 the sons of§ Ares, seven hundred fifty
six;
11 the sons of† Phaath Moab, of the sons
of Jesus and Joab, two thousand eight
hundred twelve;
12 the sons of Elam, one thousand two
hundred fifty four; the sons of‡ Zathui,
nine hundred forty five; the sons of§
Chorbe, seven hundred five; the sons of
Bani, six hundred forty eight;
13 the sons of Bebai, six hundred twenty
three; the sons of† Astad,‡ one thousand
three hundred twenty two;
14 the sons of Adonikam, six hundred
sixty seven; the sons of§ Bagoi, two
thousand sixty six; the sons of† Adinu,
four hundred fifty four;
15 the sons of‡ Ater, of Ezekias, ninety
two; the sons of Kilan and Azetas, sixty
seven; the sons of§ Azaru, four hundred
thirty two;
16 the sons of† Annis, one hundred one;
the sons of Arom, the sons of‡ Bassai,
three hundred twenty three; the sons of
Arsiphurith, one hundred twelve;
17 the sons of Baiterus, three thousand
five; the sons of§ Bethlomon, one hundred
twenty three;
18 those from Netophas, fifty five; those
from Anathoth, one hundred fifty eight;
those from† Bethasmoth, forty two;
19 those from ‡Kariathiarius, twenty
five: those from Caphira and Beroth,
seven hundred forty three;
20 the Chadiasai and Ammidioi, four
hundred twenty two; those from §Kirama

* **5:7** Ezra 2:1 † **5:8** *Seralah.* ‡ **5:8** Or, *Enenis.* § **5:8** *Mispar.* † **5:8** *Reclaiah* ‡ **5:9** *Shephatiah.* § **5:10** *Arah.* † **5:11** *Pahath-moab.* ‡ **5:12** *Zattu.* § **5:12** *Zaccai.* † **5:13** *Asgad.* ‡ **5:13** According to other readings, 3622, or 3222. § **5:14** *Bigvai.* † **5:14** *Adin.* ‡ **5:15** *Ater of Hezekiah.* § **5:15** Another reading is, *Azuru.* † **5:16** Another reading is, *Annias.* ‡ **5:16** *Bezai.* § **5:17** *Bethlehem.* † **5:18** *Azmaveth.* ‡ **5:19** *Kiriath-arim* or *Kiriath-jearim.* § **5:20** *Rumah.* † **5:20** *Geba.*

and †Gabbe, six hundred twenty one;
21 those from ‡Macalon, one hundred twenty two; those from §Betolion, fifty two; the sons of †Niphis, one hundred fifty six;
22 the sons of ‡Calamolalus and §Onus, seven hundred twenty five; the sons of †Jerechu, ‡three hundred forty five;
23 and the sons of §Sanaas, three thousand three hundred thirty.
24 The priests: the sons of †Jeddu, the son of Jesus, among the sons of Sanasib, nine hundred seventy two; the sons of ‡Emmeruth, one thousand fifty two;
25 the sons of §Phassurus, one thousand two hundred forty seven; and the sons of †Charme, one thousand seventeen.
26 The Levites: the sons of Jesus, Kadmiel, Bannas, and Sudias, seventy four.
27 The holy singers: the sons of Asaph, one hundred twenty eight.
28 The gatekeepers: the sons of‡ Salum, the sons of§ Atar, the sons of Tolman, the sons of† Dacubi, the sons of‡ Ateta, the sons of§ Sabi, in all one hundred thirty nine.
29 The temple servants: the sons of† Esau, the sons of‡ Asipha, the sons of Tabaoth, the sons of§ Keras, the sons of† Sua, the sons of‡ Phaleas, the sons of Labana, the sons of§ Aggaba.
30 the sons of† Acud, the sons of Uta, the sons of Ketab, the sons of‡ Accaba, the sons of§ Subai, the sons of† Anan, the sons of‡ Cathua, the sons of§ Geddur,
31 the sons of† Jairus, the sons of‡ Daisan, the sons of§ Noeba, the sons of Chaseba, the sons of† Gazera, the sons of‡ Ozias, the sons of§ Phinoe, the sons of Asara, the sons of† Basthai, the sons of‡ Asana, the sons of§ Maani, the sons of† Naphisi, the sons of‡ Acub, the sons of§ Achipha, the sons of† Asur, the sons of Pharakim, the sons of‡ Basaloth,
32 the sons of§ Meedda, the sons of Cutha, the sons of† Charea, the sons of‡ Barchus, the sons of§ Serar, the sons of† Thomei, the sons of‡ Nasi, the sons of Atipha.
33 The sons of the servants of Solomon: the sons of§ Assaphioth, the sons of† Pharida, the sons of‡ Jeeli, the sons of§ Lozon, the sons of† Isdael, the sons of‡ Saphuthi,
34 the sons of§ Agia, the sons of† Phacareth, the sons of Sabie, the sons of Sarothie, the sons of‡ Masias, the sons of Gas, the sons of Addus, the sons of Subas, the sons of Apherra, the sons of Barodis, the sons of Saphat, the sons of Allon.
35 All the temple-servants and the sons of the servants of Solomon were three hundred seventy two.
36 These came up from§ Thermeleth, and† Thelersas,‡ Charaathalan leading them, and Allar;
37 and they could not show their families, nor their stock, how they were of Israel: the sons of§ Dalan the son of† Ban, the sons of‡ Nekodan, six hundred fifty two.
38 Of the priests, those who usurped the office of the priesthood and were not found: the sons of§ Obdia, the sons of† Akkos, the sons of Jaddus, who married

‡ **5:21** *Michmas.* § **5:21** *Bethel.* † **5:21** *Magbish* ‡ **5:22** *Lod, Hadid.* § **5:22** *Ono.* † **5:22** *Jericho.* ‡ **5:22** Another reading is, *two* § **5:23** *Senaah.* † **5:24** *Jedaiah.* ‡ **5:24** *Immer.* § **5:25** *Pashhur.* † **5:25** *Harim.* ‡ **5:28** *Shallum.* § **5:28** *Ater.* † **5:28** *Akkub.* ‡ **5:28** *Hatita.* § **5:28** *Shobai.* † **5:29** *Ziha.* ‡ **5:29** *Hasupha.* § **5:29** *Keros.* † **5:29** *Siaha.* ‡ **5:29** *Padon.* § **5:29** *Hagaba.* † **5:30** *Akkub.* ‡ **5:30** *Hagab.* § **5:30** *Shamlai.* † **5:30** *Hanan.* ‡ **5:30** *Giddel.* § **5:30** *Gahar* † **5:31** *Reaiah.* ‡ **5:31** *Rezin.* § **5:31** *Nekoda.* † **5:31** *Gazzam.* ‡ **5:31** *Uzza.* § **5:31** *Paseah.* † **5:31** *Besai.* ‡ **5:31** *Asnah.* § **5:31** *Meunim.* † **5:31** *Nephisim.* ‡ **5:31** *Bakbuk.* According to other readings, *Acum,* or *Acuph.* § **5:31** *Hakupha.* † **5:31** *Harhur.* ‡ **5:31** *Bazluth.* § **5:32** *Mehida.* † **5:32** *Harsha* ‡ **5:32** *Barkos.* § **5:32** *Sisera.* † **5:32** *Temah* ‡ **5:32** *Neziah.* Another reading is, *Nasith.* § **5:33** *Hussophereth.* † **5:33** *Peruda.* ‡ **5:33** *Jaalah.* § **5:33** *Darkon.* † **5:33** *Giddel.* ‡ **5:33** *Shephatia.* § **5:34** *Hattil.* † **5:34** *Pochereth-haz-zebaim,* Ezra 2:57. ‡ **5:34** Another reading is, *Misaias.* § **5:36** *Telmelah.* † **5:36** *Telharsha.* ‡ **5:36** *Cherub. Addan.* § **5:37** *Delaiah.* Another reading is, *Asan.* † **5:37** *Tobiah* Another reading is, *Baenan.* ‡ **5:37** *Nekoda.* § **5:38** *Habaiah,* or *Hobaiah.* † **5:38** *Hakkoz.* ‡ **5:38** *Barzillai.* Another reading is, *Phaezeldaeus.*

Augia one of the daughters of‡ Zorzelleus, and was called after his name.
39 When the description of the kindred of these men was sought in the register and was not found, they were removed from executing the office of the priesthood;
40 for Nehemias and Attharias told them that they should not be partakers of the holy things until a high priest wearing§ Urim and Thummim should arise.
41 So all those of Israel, from twelve years old and upward, beside menservants and women servants, were in number forty two thousand three hundred sixty.
42 Their menservants and handmaids were seven thousand three hundred thirty and seven; the minstrels and singers, two hundred forty five;
43 four hundred thirty and five camels, seven thousand thirty six horses, two hundred forty five mules, and five thousand five hundred twenty five beasts of burden.
44 And some of the chief men of their families, when they came to the temple of God that is in Jerusalem, vowed to set up the house again in its own place according to their ability,
45 and to give into the holy treasury of the works one thousand minas† of gold, five thousand minas of silver, and one hundred priestly vestments.
46 The priests and the Levites and some of the people lived in Jerusalem and the country. The holy singers also and the gatekeepers and all Israel lived in their villages.
47 But when the seventh month was at hand, and when the children of Israel were each in their own place, they all came together with one purpose into the broad place before the first porch which is toward the east.
48 Then Jesus the son of Josedek, his kindred the priests, Zorobabel the son of Salathiel, and his kindred stood up and made the altar of the God of Israel ready
49 to offer burned sacrifices upon it, in accordance with the express commands in the book of Moses the man of God.
50 Some people joined them out of the other nations of the land, and they erected the altar upon its own place, because all the nations of the land were hostile to them and oppressed them; and they offered sacrifices at the proper times and burnt offerings to the Lord both morning and evening.
51 They also held the feast of tabernacles, as it is commanded in the law, and offered sacrifices daily, as appropriate.
52 After that, they offered the continual oblations and the sacrifices of the Sabbaths, of the new moons, and of all the consecrated feasts.
53 All those who had made any vow to God began to offer sacrifices to God from the new moon of the seventh month, although the temple of God was not yet built.
54 They gave money, food, and drink to the masons and carpenters.
55 They also gave carts to the people of Sidon and Tyre, that they should bring cedar trees from Libanus, and convey them in rafts to the harbor of Joppa, according to the commandment which was written for them by Cyrus king of the Persians.
56 In the second year after his coming to the temple of God at Jerusalem, in the second month, Zorobabel the son of Salathiel, Jesus the son of Josedek, their kindred, the Levitical priests, and all those who had come to Jerusalem out of the captivity began work.
57 They laid the foundation of God's temple on the new moon of the second month, in the second year after they had come to Judea and Jerusalem.
58 *They appointed the Levites who were at least twenty years old over the Lord's works. Then Jesus, with his sons and kindred, Kadmiel his brother, the sons of Jesus, Emadabun, and the sons of Joda the son of Iliadun, and their sons and

§ **5:40** Gr. *the manifestation and truth.* † **5:45** A mina is about 570 grams or 1.25 pounds. * **5:58** Ezra 3:8-9

kindred, all the Levites, with one accord stood up and started the business, laboring to advance the works in the house of God. So the builders built the Lord's temple.

59 The priests stood arrayed in their vestments with musical instruments and trumpets, and the Levites the sons of Asaph with their cymbals,
60 singing songs of thanksgiving and praising the Lord, according to the directions of King David of Israel.
61 They sang aloud, praising the Lord in songs of thanksgiving, because his goodness and his glory are forever in all Israel.
62 All the people sounded trumpets and shouted with a loud voice, singing songs of thanksgiving to the Lord for the raising up of the Lord's house.
63 *Some of the Levitical priests and of the heads of their families, the elderly who had seen the former house came to the building of this one with lamentation and great weeping.
64 But many with trumpets and joy shouted with a loud voice,
65 so that the people couldn't hear the trumpets for the weeping of the people, for the multitude sounded loudly, so that it was heard far away.

66 *Therefore when the enemies of the tribe of Judah and Benjamin heard it, they came to know what that noise of trumpets meant.
67 They learned that those who returned from captivity built the temple for the Lord, the God of Israel.
68 So they went to Zorobabel and Jesus, and to the chief men of the families, and said to them, "We will build together with you.
69 For we, just like you, obey your Lord, and sacrifice to him from the days of King ‡Asbasareth of the Assyrians, who brought us here."

70 Then Zorobabel, Jesus and the chief men of the families of Israel said to them, "It is not for you to build the house for the Lord our God.
71 We ourselves alone will build for the Lord of Israel, as King Cyrus of the Persians has commanded us."
72 But the heathen of the land pressed hard upon the inhabitants of Judea, cut off their supplies, and hindered their building.
73 By their secret plots, and popular persuasions and commotions, they hindered the finishing of the building all the time that King Cyrus lived. So they were hindered from building for two years, until the reign of Darius.

6

1 Now *in the second year of the reign of Darius, Aggaeus and Zacharius the son of† Addo, the prophets, prophesied to the Jews in Judea and Jerusalem in the name of the Lord, the God of Israel.
2 Then Zorobabel the son of Salathiel and Jesus the son of Josedek stood up and began to build the house of the Lord at Jerusalem, the prophets of the Lord being with them and helping them.

3 *At the same time ‡Sisinnes the governor of Syria and Phoenicia came to them, with §Sathrabuzanes and his companions, and said to them,
4 "By whose authority do you build this house and this roof, and perform all the other things? Who are the builders who do these things?"
5 Nevertheless, the elders of the Jews obtained favor, because the Lord had visited the captives;
6 and they were not hindered from building until such time as communication was made to Darius concerning them, and his answer received.
7 A copy of the letter which Sisinnes, governor of Syria and Phoenicia, and Sathrabuzanes, with their companions, the rulers in Syria and Phoenicia, wrote and sent to Darius:

* **5:63** Ezra 3:12-13 * **5:66** Ezra 4:1 ‡ **5:69** Another reading is, *Asbacaphath.* * **6:1** Ezra 4:24; 5:1 † **6:1** *Iddo.* Another reading is, *Eddin* * **6:3** Ezra 5:3 ‡ **6:3** *Tattenai.* § **6:3** *Shetharbozenai*

8 “To King Darius, greetings. Let it be
fully known to our lord the king, that
having come into the country of Judea,
and entered into the city of Jerusalem, we
found in the city of Jerusalem the elders of
the Jews that were of the captivity
9 building a great new house for the
Lord of hewn and costly stones, with
timber laid in the walls.
10 Those works are being done with
great speed. The work goes on
prosperously in their hands, and it is
being accomplished with all glory and
diligence.
11 Then we asked these elders, saying,
‘By whose authority are you building this
house and laying the foundations of these
works?’
12 Therefore, to the intent that we might
give knowledge to you by writing who the
leaders were, we questioned them, and
we required of them the names in writing
of their principal men.
13 So they gave us this answer, ‘We are
the servants of the Lord who made
heaven and earth.
14 As for this house, it was built many
years ago by a great and strong king of
Israel, and was finished.
15 But when our fathers sinned against
the Lord of Israel who is in heaven, and
provoked him to wrath, he gave them over
into the hands of King Nabuchodonosor of
Babylon, king of the Chaldeans.
16 They pulled down the house, burned
it, and carried away the people captive to
Babylon.
17 But in the first year that Cyrus reigned
over the country of Babylon, King Cyrus
wrote that this house should be rebuilt.
18 The holy vessels of gold and of silver
that Nabuchodonosor had carried away
out of the house at Jerusalem and had set
up in his own temple, those King Cyrus
brought out of the temple in Babylonia,
and they were delivered to Zorobabel and
to †Sanabassarus the governor,
19 with commandment that he should
carry away all these vessels, and put them
in the temple at Jerusalem, and that the
Lord’s temple should be built on its site.
20 Then Sanabassarus, having come
here, laid the foundations of the Lord’s
house which is in Jerusalem. From that
time to this we are still building. It is not
yet fully completed.’
21 Now therefore, if it seems good, O
king, let a search be made among the
royal archives of our lord the king that are
in Babylon.
22 If it is found that the building of the
house of the Lord which is in Jerusalem
has been done with the consent of King
Cyrus, and it seems good to our lord the
king, let him send us directions
concerning these things.”

23 *Then King Darius commanded that a
search be made among the archives that
were laid up at Babylon. So at Ekbatana
the palace, which is in the country of
Media, a scroll was found where these
things were recorded:
24 “In the first year of the reign of Cyrus,
King Cyrus commanded to build up the
house of the Lord which is in Jerusalem,
where they sacrifice with continual fire.
25 Its height shall be sixty cubits, and the
breadth sixty cubits, with three rows of
hewn stones, and one row of new wood
from that country. Its expenses are to be
given out of the house of King Cyrus.
26 The holy vessels of the house of the
Lord, both gold and silver, that
Nabuchodonosor took out of the house at
Jerusalem and carried away to Babylon,
should be restored to the house at
Jerusalem, and be set in the place where
they were before.”
27 Also he commanded that Sisinnes the
governor of Syria and Phoenicia, and
Sathrabuzanes, and their companions,
and those who were appointed rulers in
Syria and Phoenicia, should be careful not
to meddle with the place, but allow
Zorobabel, the servant of the Lord, and
governor of Judea, and the elders of the
Jews, to build that house of the Lord in its
place.
28 “I also command to have it built up

† **6:18** Another reading is, *Sabunassarus.* * **6:23** Ezra 6:1

whole again; and that they look diligently to help those who are of the captivity of Judea, until the house of the Lord is finished,
29 and that out of the tribute of Coelesyria and Phoenicia a portion shall be carefully given to these men for the sacrifices of the Lord, that is, to Zorobabel the governor for bulls, rams, and lambs,
30 and also corn, salt, wine and oil, and that continually every year without further question, according as the priests who are in Jerusalem may direct to be daily spent,
31 that drink offerings may be made to the Most High God for the king and for his children, and that they may pray for their lives."
32 He commanded that whoever should transgress, yes, or neglect anything written here, a beam shall be taken out of his own house, and he shall be hanged on it, and all his goods seized for the king.
33 "Therefore may the Lord, whose name is called upon there, utterly destroy every king and nation that stretches out his hand to hinder or damage that house of the Lord in Jerusalem.
34 I, King Darius have ordained that these things be done with diligence."

7

1 Then *Sisinnes the governor of Coelesyria and Phoenicia, and Sathrabuzanes, with their companions, following the commandments of King Darius,
2 very carefully supervised the holy work, assisting the elders of the Jews and rulers of the temple.
3 So the holy work prospered, while Aggaeus and Zacharias the prophets prophesied.
4 They finished these things by the commandment of the Lord, the God of Israel, and with the consent of Cyrus, Darius, and Artaxerxes, kings of the Persians.
5 So the holy house was finished by the twenty-third day of the month Adar, in the sixth year of King Darius.
6 The children of Israel, the priests, the Levites, and the others who returned from captivity who joined them did what was written in the book of Moses.
7 For the dedication of the Lord's temple, they offered one hundred bulls, two hundred rams, four hundred lambs,
8 and twelve male goats for the sin of all Israel, according to the number of the twelve princes of the tribes of Israel.
9 The priests and the Levites stood arrayed in their vestments, according to their kindred, for the services of the Lord, the God of Israel, according to the book of Moses. The gatekeepers were at every gate.
10 The children of Israel who came out of captivity held the Passover the fourteenth day of the first month, when the priests and the Levites were sanctified together,
11 with all those who returned from captivity; for they were sanctified. For the Levites were all sanctified together,
12 and they offered the Passover for all who returned from captivity, for their kindred the priests, and for themselves.
13 The children of Israel who came out of the captivity ate, even all those who had separated themselves from the abominations of the heathen of the land, and sought the Lord.
14 They kept the feast of unleavened bread seven days, rejoicing before the Lord,
15 because he had turned the counsel of the king of Assyria toward them, to strengthen their hands in the works of the Lord, the God of Israel.

8

1 *After these things, when Artaxerxes the king of the Persians reigned, Esdras came, who was the son of Azaraias, the son of Zechrias, the son of Helkias, the son of Salem,

* **7:1** Ezra 6:13 * **8:1** Ezra 7:1 † **8:2** The Vatican MS. omits *the son of Memeroth, the son of Zaraias, the son of Savias.*

2 the son of Sadduk, the son of Ahitob,
the son of Amarias, the son of Ozias,† the
son of Memeroth, the son of Zaraias, the
son of Savias, the son of Boccas, the son of
Abisne, the son of Phinees, the son of
Eleazar, the son of Aaron, the chief priest.
3 This Esdras went up from Babylon as a
skilled scribe in the law of Moses, which
was given by the God of Israel.
4 The king honored him, for he found
favor in his sight in all his requests.
5 There went up with him also some of
the children of Israel, and of the priests,
Levites, holy singers, gatekeepers, and
temple servants to Jerusalem
6 in the seventh year of the reign of
Artaxerxes, in the fifth month (this was
the king's seventh year); for they left
Babylon on the new moon of the first
month and came to Jerusalem, by the
prosperous journey which the Lord gave
them‡ for his sake.
7 For Esdras had very great skill, so that
he omitted nothing of the law and
commandments of the Lord, but taught all
Israel the ordinances and judgments.
8 Now the commission, which was
written from King Artaxerxes, came to
Esdras the priest and reader of the law of
the Lord, was as follows:
9 "King Artaxerxes to Esdras the priest
and reader of the law of the Lord,
greetings.
10 Having determined to deal
graciously, I have given orders that those
of the nation of the Jews, and of the priests
and Levites, and of those within our
realm who are willing and freely choose
to, should go with you to Jerusalem.
11 As many therefore as are so disposed,
let them depart with you, as it has seemed
good both to me and my seven friends the
counselors,
12 that they may look to the affairs of
Judea and Jerusalem, in accordance with
what is in the Lord's law,
13 and carry the gifts to the Lord of Israel
to Jerusalem, which I and my friends have
vowed, and that all the gold and silver
that can be found in the country of
Babylonia for the Lord in Jerusalem,
14 with that also which is given of the
people for the temple of the Lord their
God that is at Jerusalem, be collected:
even the gold and silver for bulls, rams,
and lambs, and what goes with them,
15 to the end that they may offer
sacrifices to the Lord upon the altar of the
Lord their God, which is in Jerusalem.
16 Whatever you and your kindred
decide to do with gold and silver, do that
according to the will of your God.
17 The holy vessels of the Lord, which
are given you for the use of the temple of
your God, which is in Jerusalem,
18 and whatever else you shall
remember for the use of the temple of
your God, you shall give it out of the king's
treasury.
19 I, King Artaxerxes, have also
commanded the keepers of the treasures
in Syria and Phoenicia, that whatever
Esdras the priest and reader of the law of
the Most High God shall send for, they
should give it to him with all diligence,
20 to the sum of one hundred talents of
silver, likewise also of wheat even to one
hundred cors§, and one hundred firkins†
of wine, and‡ salt in abundance.
21 Let all things be performed after
God's law diligently to the most high God,
that wrath come not upon the kingdom of
the king and his sons.
22 I command you also that no tax, nor
any other imposition, be laid upon any of
the priests, or Levites, or holy singers, or
gatekeepers, or temple servants, or any
that have employment in this temple, and
that no man has authority to impose any
tax on them.
23 You, Esdras, according to the wisdom
of God, ordain judges and justices that
they may judge in all Syria and Phoenicia
all those who know the law of your God;
and those who don't know it, you shall
teach.

‡ **8:6** Some MSS. omit *for his sake.*
† **8:20** a firkin is about 41 liters or 11 gallons.
§ **8:20** a cor is about 230 liters, so 100 cors is about 23 kiloliters or 652 bushels
‡ **8:20** So some authorities. See Ezra 7:22. The common reading is, *other things.*

24 Whoever transgresses the law of your
God and of the king shall be punished
diligently, whether it be by death, or other
punishment, by penalty of money, or by
imprisonment."

25 Then Esdras the scribe said, "Blessed
be the only Lord, the God of my fathers,
who has put these things into the heart of
the king, to glorify his house that is in
Jerusalem,
26 and has honored me in the sight of
the king, his counselors, and all his
friends and nobles.
27 Therefore I was encouraged by the
help of the Lord my God, and gathered
together out of Israel men to go up with
me.

28 These are the chiefs according to their
families and their several divisions, who
went up with me from Babylon in the
reign of King Artaxerxes:
29 of the sons of Phinees, Gerson; of the
sons of Ithamar, Gamael; of the sons of
David,§ Attus† the son of Sechenias;
30 of the sons of Phoros, Zacharais; and
with him were counted one hundred fifty
men;
31 of the sons of Phaath Moab, Eliaonias
the son of‡ Zaraias, and with him two
hundred men;
32 §of the sons of Zathoes, Sechenias the
son of Jezelus, and with him three
hundred men; of the sons of Adin, Obeth
the son of Jonathan, and with him two
hundred fifty men;
33 of the sons of Elam, Jesias son of
Gotholias, and with him seventy men;
34 of the sons of Saphatias, Zaraias son
of Michael, and with him seventy men;
35 of the sons of Joab, Abadias son of
Jehiel. Jezelus, and with him two hundred
twelve men;
36 †of the sons of Banias, Salimoth son of
Josaphias, and with him one hundred
sixty men;
37 of the sons of Babi, Zacharias son of
Bebai, and with him twenty-eight men;
38 of the sons of Azgad: Astath, Joannes
son of Hakkatan Akatan, and with him
one hundred ten men;
39 of the sons of Adonikam, the last, and
these are the names of them, Eliphalat,
Jeuel, and Samaias, and with them
seventy men;
40 of the sons of Bago, Uthi the son of
Istalcurus, and with him seventy men.

41 I gathered them together to the river
called Theras. There we pitched our tents
three days, and I inspected them.
42 When I had found there none of the
priests and Levites,
43 then sent I to Eleazar, Iduel, Maasmas,
44 Elnathan, Samaias, Joribus, Nathan,
Ennatan, Zacharias, and Mosollamus,
principal men and men of understanding.
45 I asked them to go to Loddeus the
captain, who was in the place of the
treasury,
46 and commanded them that they
should speak to Loddeus, to his kindred,
and to the treasurers in that place, to send
us such men as might execute the priests'
office in our Lord's house.
47 By the mighty hand of our Lord, they
brought to us men of understanding of the
sons of‡ Mooli the son of Levi, the son of
Israel,§ Asebebias, and his sons, and his
kindred, who were eighteen,
48 and† Asebias, Annuus, and Osaias his
brother, of the sons of Chanuneus, and
their sons were twenty men;
49 and of the temple servants whom
David and the principal men had
appointed for the servants of the Levites,
two hundred twenty temple servants. The
list of all their names was reported.

50 There I vowed a fast for the young
men before our Lord, to seek from him a
prosperous journey both for us and for
our children and livestock that were with
us;
51 for I was ashamed to ask of the king
infantry, cavalry, and an escort for
protection against our adversaries.

§ **8:29** *Hattush.* † **8:29** Ezra 8:3, *of the sons of Shecaniah; of the sons of Parosh.* ‡ **8:31** *Zerehiah.* § **8:32** Ezra 8:5, *of the sons of Shecaniah, the son of Jahaziel.* † **8:36** Ezra 8:10, *of the sons of Shelomith, the son of Josiphiah.* ‡ **8:47** *Mahli.* § **8:47** *Sherebiah.* † **8:48** *Hashabiah.*

52 For we had said to the king that the
power of our Lord would be with those
who seek him, to support them in all ways.
53 Again we prayed to our lord about
these things, and found him to be
merciful.
54 Then I set apart twelve men of the
chiefs of the priests,‡ Eserebias, Assamias,
and ten men of their kindred with them.
55 I weighed out to them the silver, the
gold, and the holy vessels of the house of
our Lord, which the king, his counselors,
the nobles, and all Israel had given.
56 When I had weighed it, I delivered to
them six hundred fifty talents of silver,
silver vessels weighing one hundred
talents, one hundred talents of gold,
57 twenty golden vessels, and twelve
vessels of brass, even of fine brass,
glittering like gold.
58 I said to them, "You are holy to the
Lord, the vessels are holy, and the gold
and the silver are a vow to the Lord, the
Lord of our fathers.
59 Watch and keep them until you
deliver them to the chiefs of the priests
and Levites, and to the principal men of
the families of Israel in Jerusalem, in the
chambers of our Lord's house.
60 So the priests and the Levites who
received the silver, the gold, and the
vessels which were in Jerusalem, brought
them into the temple of the Lord.

61 We left the river Theras on the twelfth
day of the first month. We came to
Jerusalem by the mighty hand of our Lord
which was upon us. The Lord delivered us
from every enemy on the way, and so we
came to Jerusalem.
62 When we had been there three days,
the silver and gold was weighed and
delivered in our Lord's house on the
fourth day to§ Marmoth the priest the son
of† Urias.
63 With him was Eleazar the son of
Phinees, and with them were Josabdus
the son of Jesus and‡ Moeth the son of
Sabannus, the Levites. All was delivered
to them by number and weight.
64 All the weight of them was recorded
at the same hour.
65 Moreover those who had come out of
captivity offered sacrifices to the Lord, the
God of Israel, even twelve bulls for all
Israel, ninety-six rams,
66 seventy-two lambs, and twelve goats
for a peace offering—all of them a
sacrifice to the Lord.
67 They delivered the king's
commandments to the king's stewards
and to the governors of Coelesyria and
Phoenicia; and they honored the people
and the temple of the Lord.

68 Now when these things were done,
the principal men came to me and said,
69 "The nation of Israel, the princes, the
priests, and the Levites haven't put away
from themselves the foreign people of the
land nor the uncleannesses of the
Gentiles—the Canaanites, Hittites,
Pherezites, Jebusites, Moabites, Egyptians,
and Edomites.
70 For both they and their sons have
married with their daughters, and the
holy seed is mixed with the foreign people
of the land. From the beginning of this
matter the rulers and the nobles have
been partakers of this iniquity."

71 And as soon as I had heard these
things, I tore my clothes and my holy
garment, and plucked the hair from off
my head and beard, and sat down sad and
full of heaviness.
72 So all those who were moved at the
word of the Lord, the God of Israel,
assembled to me while I mourned for the
iniquity, but I sat still full of heaviness
until the evening sacrifice.
73 Then rising up from the fast with my
clothes and my holy garment torn, and
bowing my knees and stretching out my
hands to the Lord,
74 I said, "O Lord, I am ashamed and
confounded before your face,
75 for our sins are multiplied above our
heads, and our errors have reached up to
heaven
76 ever since the time of our fathers. We
are in great sin, even to this day.

‡ **8:54** *Sherebiah, Hashabiah.* § **8:62** *Meremoth.* † **8:62** *Uriah.* ‡ **8:63** *Noadiah the son of Binnui.*

77 For our sins and our fathers' sins we with our kindred, our kings, and our priests were given up to the kings of the earth, to the sword, and to captivity, and for a prey with shame, to this day.
78 Now in some measure mercy has been shown to us from you, O Lord, that there should be left us a root and a name in the place of your sanctuary,
79 and to uncover a light in the house of the Lord our God, and to give us food in the time of our servitude.
80 Yes, when we were in bondage, we were not forsaken by our Lord, but he gave us favor before the kings of Persia, so that they gave us food,
81 glorified the temple of our Lord, and raised up the desolate Zion, to give us a sure dwelling in Judea and Jerusalem.
82 "Now, O Lord, what shall we say, having these things? For we have transgressed your commandments which you gave by the hand of your servants the prophets, saying,
83 'The land, which you enter into to possess as an inheritance, is a land polluted with the pollutions of the foreigners of the land, and they have filled it with their uncleanness.
84 Therefore now you shall not join your daughters to their sons, neither shall you take their daughters for your sons.
85 You shall never seek to have peace with them, that you may be strong, and eat the good things of the land, and that you may leave it for an inheritance to your children for evermore.'
86 All that has happened is done to us for our wicked works and great sins, for you, O Lord, made our sins light,
87 and gave to us such a root; but we have turned back again to transgress your law in mingling ourselves with the uncleanness of the heathen of the land.
88 You weren't angry with us to destroy us until you had left us neither root, seed, nor name.
89 O Lord of Israel, you are true, for we are left a root this day.
90 Behold, now we are before you in our iniquities, for we can't stand any longer before you because of these things."
91 *As Esdras in his prayer made his confession, weeping, and lying flat on the ground before the temple, a very great throng of men, women, and children gathered to him from Jerusalem; for there was great weeping among the multitude.
92 Then Jechonias the son of Jeelus, one of the sons of Israel, called out, and said, "O Esdras, we have sinned against the Lord God, we have married foreign women of the heathen of the land, but there is still hope for Israel.
93 Let's make an oath to the Lord about this, that we will put away all our foreign wives with their children,
94 as seems good to you, and to as many as obey the Lord's Law.
95 Arise, and take action, for this is your task, and we will be with you to do valiantly."
96 So Esdras arose, and took an oath from the chief of the priests and Levites of all Israel to do these things; and they swore to it.

9

1 *Then Esdras rose up from the court of the temple and went to the chamber of Jonas the son of Eliasib,
2 and lodged there, and ate no bread and drank no water, mourning for the great iniquities of the multitude.
3 A proclamation was made in all Judea and Jerusalem to all those who returned from captivity, that they should be gathered together at Jerusalem,
4 and that whoever didn't meet there within two or three days, in accordance with the ruling of the elders, that their livestock would be seized for the use of the temple, and they would be expelled from the multitude of those who returned from captivity.
5 Within three days, all those of the tribe of Judah and Benjamin gathered together at Jerusalem. This was the ninth month, on the twentieth day of the month.

* **8:91** Ezra 10:1 * **9:1** Ezra 10:6

6 All the multitude sat together
shivering in the broad place before the
temple because of the present foul
weather.
7 So Esdras arose up and said to them,
“You have transgressed the law and
married foreign wives, increasing the sins
of Israel.
8 Now make confession and give glory
to the Lord, the God of our fathers,
9 and do his will, and separate
yourselves from the heathen of the land,
and from the foreign women.”
10 Then the whole multitude cried out,
and said with a loud voice, “Just as you
have spoken, so we will do.
11 But because the multitude is great,
and it is foul weather, so that we can’t
stand outside, and this is not a work of
one day or two, seeing our sin in these
things has spread far,
12 therefore let the rulers of the
multitude stay, and let all those of our
settlements that have foreign wives come
at the time appointed,
13 and with them the rulers and judges
of every place, until we turn away the
wrath of the Lord from us for this matter.”
14 So Jonathan the son of Azael and†
Ezekias the son of Thocanus took the
matter on themselves. Mosollamus and
Levis and Sabbateus were judges with
them.
15 Those who returned from captivity
did according to all these things.
16 Esdras the priest chose for himself
principal men of their families, all by
name. On the new moon of the tenth
month they met together to examine the
matter.
17 So their cases of men who had foreign
wives was brought to an end by the new
moon of the first month.
18 Of the priests who had come together
and had foreign wives, there were found
19 of the sons of Jesus the son of Josedek,
and his kindred,‡ Mathelas, Eleazar, and§
Joribus, and† Joadanus.
20 They gave their hands to put away
their wives, and to offer rams to make
reconciliation for their error.
21 Of the sons of Emmer: Ananias,
Zabdeus, ‡Manes, §Sameus, †Hiereel, and
‡Azarias.
22 Of the sons of §Phaisur: Elionas,
Massias, Ishmael, Nathanael, †Ocidelus,
and ‡Saloas.
23 Of the Levites: Jozabdus, Semeis,
§Colius who was called †Calitas, ‡Patheus,
Judas, and Jonas.
24 Of the holy singers: §Eliasibus and
Bacchurus.
25 Of the gatekeepers: Sallumus and†
Tolbanes.
26 Of Israel, of the sons of Phoros:‡
Hiermas,§ Ieddias,† Melchias, Maelus,‡
Eleazar, Asibas, §and Banneas.
27 Of the sons of Ela: Matthanias,
Zacharias, †Jezrielus, Oabdius,
Hieremoth, and‡ Aedias.
28 Of the sons of §Zamoth: †Eliadas,
‡Eliasimus, §Othonias, Jarimoth,
†Sabathus, and ‡Zardeus.
29 Of the sons of Bebai: Joannes,
Ananias, §Jozabdus, and †Ematheis.
30 Of the sons of ‡Mani: §Olamus,
†Mamuchus, ‡Jedeus, Jasubas, §Jasaelus,
and Hieremoth.
31 Of the sons of Addi: Naathus,
Moossias, Laccunus, Naidus, Matthanias,
Sesthel, Balnuus, and Manasseas.
32 Of the sons of Annas: Elionas, Aseas,
Melchias, Sabbeus, and Simon
Chosameus.
33 Of the sons of Asom: †Maltanneus,
‡Mattathias, §Sabanneus, Eliphalat,
Manasses, and Semei.
34 Of the sons of Baani: Jeremias,
Momdis, Ismaerus, Juel, Mamdai, Pedias,
Anos, Carabasion, Enasibus,

† **9:14** Another reading is, *Ezias.* ‡ **9:19** *Maaseiah.* § **9:19** *Jarib.* † **9:19** *Gedaliah* ‡ **9:21** *Harim* § **9:21** *Maaseiah.* † **9:21** *Jehiel.* ‡ **9:21** *Uzziah.* § **9:22** *Pashhur.* † **9:22** *Jozabad.* ‡ **9:22** *Elasah.* § **9:23** *Kelaiah.* † **9:23** *Kelita.* ‡ **9:23** *Pethahiah.* § **9:24** *Eliashib.* † **9:25** *Telem.* ‡ **9:26** *Parosh.* § **9:26** *Ramiah* † **9:26** *Izziah.* Another reading is, *Iezias* ‡ **9:26** *Mijamin.* § **9:26** *Malchijah.* † **9:27** *Jehiel.* ‡ **9:27** *Abdi.* § **9:28** *Zattu.* † **9:28** *Elioenai.* ‡ **9:28** *Eliashib.* § **9:28** *Mattaniah.* † **9:28** *Zabad.* ‡ **9:28** *Aziza.* § **9:29** *Zabbai.* † **9:29** *Athlai.* ‡ **9:30** *Bani.* § **9:30** *Meshullam.* † **9:30** *Malluch.* ‡ **9:30** *Adaiah.* § **9:30** *Sheal.* † **9:33** *Mattenai.* ‡ **9:33** *Mattattah.* § **9:33** *Zabad.*

Mamnitamenus, Eliasis, Bannus, Eliali, Someis, Selemias, and Nathanias. Of the sons of Ezora: Sesis, Ezril, Azaelus, Samatus, Zambri, and Josephus.
35 Of the sons of Nooma: Mazitias, Zabadeas, Edos, Juel, and Banaias.
36 All these had taken foreign wives, and they put them away with their children.
37 The priests and Levites, and those who were of Israel, lived in Jerusalem and in the country, on the new moon of the seventh month, and the children of Israel in their settlements.
38 *The whole multitude gathered together with one accord into the broad place before the porch of the temple toward the east.
39 They said to Esdras the priest and reader, "Bring the law of Moses that was given by the Lord, the God of Israel."
40 So Esdras the chief priest brought the law to the whole multitude both of men and women, and to all the priests, to hear the law on the new moon of the seventh month.
41 He read in the broad place before the porch of the temple from morning until midday, before both men and women; and all the multitude gave attention to the law.
42 Esdras the priest and reader of the law stood up upon the pulpit of wood which had been prepared.
43 Beside him stood Mattathias, Sammus, Ananias, Azarias, Urias, †Ezekias, and Baalsamus on the right hand,
44 and on his left hand, ‡Phaldeus, Misael, Melchias, §Lothasubus, Nabarias, and Zacharias.
45 Then Esdras took the book of the law before the multitude, and sat honorably in the first place before all.
46 When he opened the law, they all stood straight up. So Esdras blessed the Lord God Most High, the God of armies, the Almighty.
47 All the people answered, "Amen." Lifting up their hands, they fell to the ground and worshiped the Lord.
48 Also Jesus, Annus, Sarabias, Iadinus, Jacubus, Sabateus, †Auteas, Maiannas, Calitas, Azarias, Jozabdus, Ananias, and Phalias, the Levites, taught the law of the Lord, ‡and read to the multitude the law of the Lord, explaining what was read.
49 Then Attharates said to Esdras the chief priest and reader, and to the Levites who taught the multitude, even to all,
50 "This day is holy to the Lord—now they all wept when they heard the law—
51 go then, eat the fat, drink the sweet, and send portions to those who have nothing;
52 for the day is holy to the Lord. Don't be sorrowful, for the Lord will bring you to honor."
53 So the Levites commanded all things to the people, saying, "This day is holy. Don't be sorrowful."
54 Then they went their way, every one to eat, drink, enjoy themselves, to give portions to those who had nothing, and to rejoice greatly,
55 because they §understood the words they were instructed with, and for which they had been assembled.

* **9:38** Nehemiah 8:1 † **9:43** *Hilkiah.* ‡ **9:44** *Pedaiah.* § **9:44** *Hashuin.* † **9:48** *Hodiah.* ‡ **9:48** Some authorities omit *and read...Lord.* § **9:55** Or, *were inspired by*

The Prayer of Manasses King of Judah, When He Was Held Captive in Babylon

The Prayer of Manasses is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Greek Orthodox and Russian Orthodox Churches. It is included in an appendix to the Latin Vulgate Bible.

1 O LORD Almighty in heaven, God of
our fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob,
and of their righteous offspring,
2 you who have made heaven and earth,
with all their order,
3 who have bound the sea by the word
of your commandment, who have shut up
the deep, and sealed it by your terrible
and glorious name,
4 whom all things fear, yes, tremble
before your power,
5 for the majesty of your glory can't be
borne, and the anger of your threatening
toward sinners is unbearable.
6 Your merciful promise is
unmeasurable and unsearchable,
7 for you are the Lord Most High, of
great compassion, patient and abundant
in mercy, and relent at human suffering.
8 †You, O Lord, according to your great
goodness have promised repentance and
forgiveness to those who have sinned
against you. Of your infinite mercies, you
have appointed repentance to sinners,
that they may be saved. You therefore, O
Lord, who are the God of the just, have not
appointed repentance to the just, to
Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, which have
not sinned against you, but you have
appointed repentance to me, a sinner.
9 For I have sinned more than the
number of the sands of the sea. My
transgressions are multiplied,‡ O Lord, my
transgressions are multiplied, and I am
not worthy to behold and see the height of
heaven for the multitude of my iniquities.
10 I am bowed down with many iron
bands, so that I can't lift up my head by
reason of my sins,§ neither have I any
relief; for I have provoked your wrath,
and done that which is evil before you:† I
didn't do your will, neither did I keep your
commandments. I have set up
abominations, and have multiplied
detestable things.
11 Now therefore I bow the knee of my
heart, asking you for grace.
12 I have sinned, O Lord, I have sinned,
and I acknowledge my iniquities;
13 but, I humbly ask you, forgive me, O
Lord, forgive me, and please don't destroy
me with my iniquities. Don't be angry
with me forever, by reserving evil for me.
Don't condemn me into the lower parts of
the earth. For you, O Lord, are the God of
those who repent.
14 In me you will show all your
goodness, for you will save me, even
though I am unworthy, according to your
great mercy.
15 Then I will praise you forever all the
days of my life; for all the army of heaven
sings your praise, and yours is the glory
forever and ever. Amen.

† **1:8** The Alex. MS. omits *You... saved.* ‡ **1:9** The Alex. MS. omits *O Lord... multiplied.* § **1:10** Some authorities omit *by reason of my sins.* † **1:10** The Alex. MS. omits *I did... commandments.*

Psalm 151

Psalm 151 is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Greek Orthodox and Russian Orthodox Churches.

This Psalm is a genuine one of David, though extra,† composed when he fought in single combat with Goliath.

1 I was small among my brothers,
and youngest in my father's house.
I tended my father's sheep.
2 My hands formed a musical instrument,
and my fingers tuned a lyre.
3 Who shall tell my Lord?
The Lord himself, he himself hears.
4 He sent forth his angel and took me from my father's sheep,
and he anointed me with his anointing oil.
5 My brothers were handsome and tall;
but the Lord didn't take pleasure in them.
6 I went out to meet the Philistine,
and he cursed me by his idols.
7 But I drew his own sword and beheaded him,
and removed reproach from the children of Israel.

† **1:** or, supernumerary

The Third Book of the Maccabees

The Third Book of the Maccabees is recognized as Deuterocanonical Scripture by the Greek Orthodox and Russian Orthodox Churches. It is considered to be apocrypha by most other church traditions.

1 Now Philopater, on learning from
those who came back that Antiochus had
made himself master of the places which
belonged to himself, sent orders to all his
infantry and cavalry, took with him his
sister Arsinoe, and marched out as far as
the parts of Raphia, where Antiochus and
his forces encamped.
2 And one Theodotus, intending to carry
out his design, took with him the bravest
of the armed men who had been before
committed to his trust by Ptolemy, and got
through at night to the tent of Ptolemy, to
kill him on his own responsibility, and so
to end the war.
3 But Dositheus, called the son of
Drimulus, by birth a Jew, afterward a
renegade from the laws and observances
of his country, conveyed Ptolemy away,
and made an obscure person lie down in
his stead in the tent. It turned out that this
man received the fate which was meant
for the other.
4 A fierce battle then took place. The
men of Antiochus were prevailing.
Arsinoe continually went up and down
the ranks, and with dishevelled hair, with
tears and entreaties, begged the soldiers
to fight bravely for themselves, their
children, and wives, and promised that if
they proved conquerors, she would give
them each two minas of gold.
5 It thus fell out that their enemies were
defeated in hand-to-hand encounter, and
that many of them were taken prisoners.
6 Having vanquished this attempt, the
king then decided to proceed to the
neighboring cities, and encourage them.
7 By doing this, and by making
donations to their temples, he inspired his
subjects with confidence.
8 The Jews sent some of their council
and of their elders to him. The greetings,
welcoming gifts, and congratulations of
the past, given by them, filled him with
the greater eagerness to visit their city.
9 Having arrived at Jerusalem,
sacrificed, and offered thank-offerings to
the Greatest God, and done whatever else
was suitable to the sanctity of the place,
and entered the inner court,
10 he was so impressed with the
magnificence of the place, and so
wondered at the orderly arrangements of
the temple, that he considered entering
the sanctuary itself.
11 When they told him that this was not
permissible, none of the nation, not even
the priests in general, but only the
supreme high priest of all, and he only
once in a year, was allowed to go in, he
would by no means give way.
12 Then they read the law to him, but he
persisted in intruding, exclaiming that he
ought to be allowed. He said, “Even if they
were deprived of this honor, I shouldn’t
be.”
13 He asked why, when he entered all
the other temples, did none of the priests
who were present forbid him.
14 He was thoroughly answered by
someone, that he did wrong to boast of
this.
15 “Well, since I have done this,” said he,
“be the cause what it may, shall I not enter
with or without your consent?”
16 When the priests fell down in their
sacred vestments imploring the Greatest
God to come and help in time of need, and
to avert the violence of the fierce
aggressor, and when they filled the
temple with lamentations and tears,
17 then those who had been left behind
in the city were scared, and rushed out,
uncertain of the event.
18 Virgins, who had been shut up within
their chambers, came out with their
mothers, scattering dust and ashes on
their heads, and filling the streets with
outcries.
19 Women who had recently been
arrayed for marriage left their bridal

chambers, left the reserve that befitted them, and ran around the city in a disorderly manner.
20 New-born babes were deserted by the mothers or nurses who waited upon them—some here, some there, in houses, or in fields; these now, with an ardor which could not be checked, swarmed into the Most High temple.
21 Various prayers were offered up by those who assembled in this place because of the unholy attempt of the king.
22 Along with these there were some of the citizens who took courage and would not submit to his obstinacy and his intention of carrying out his purpose.
23 Calling out to arms, and to die bravely in defense of the law of their fathers, they created a great uproar in the place, and were with difficulty brought back by the aged and the elders to the station of prayer which they had occupied before.
24 During this time, the multitude kept on praying.
25 The elders who surrounded the king tried in many ways to divert his arrogant mind from the design which he had formed.
26 He, in his hardened mood, insensible to all persuasion, was going onward with the view of carrying out this design.
27 Yet even his own officers, when they saw this, joined the Jews in an appeal to Him who has all power to aid in the present crisis, and not wink at such haughty lawlessness.
28 Such was the frequency and the vehemence of the cry of the assembled crowd, that an indescribable noise ensued.
29 Not the men only, but the very walls and floor seemed to sound out, all things preferring death rather than to see the place defiled.

2

1 Now it was that the high priest Simon bowed his knees near the holy place, spread out his hands in reverent form, and uttered the following prayer:
2 "O Lord, Lord, King of the heavens, and Ruler of the whole creation, Holy among the holy, sole Governor, Almighty, give ear to us who are oppressed by a wicked and profane one, who celebrates in his confidence and strength.
3 It is you, the Creator of all, the Lord of the universe, who are a righteous Governor, and judge all who act with pride and insolence.
4 It was you who destroyed the former workers of unrighteousness, among whom were the giants, who trusted in their strength and daring, by covering them with a measureless flood.
5 It was you who made the Sodomites, those workers of exceedingly iniquity, men notorious for their vices, an example to later generations, when you covered them with fire and brimstone†.
6 You made known your power when you caused the bold Pharaoh, the enslaver of your people, to pass through the ordeal of many and diverse inflictions.
7 You rolled the depths of the sea over him when he pursued with chariots and with a multitude of followers, and gave a safe passage to those who put their trust in you, the Lord of the whole creation.
8 These saw and felt the works of your hands, and praised you, the Almighty.
9 You, O King, when you created the immeasurable and measureless earth, chose this city. You made this place sacred to your name, even though you need nothing. You glorified it with your illustrious presence, after constructing it to the glory of your great and honorable name.
10 You promised, out of love for the people of Israel, that if we fall away from you, become afflicted, and then come to this house and pray, you would hear our prayer.
11 Truly you are faithful and true.
12 When you often aided our fathers when hard pressed and humiliated, and delivered them out of great dangers,
13 see now, holy King, how through our many and great sins we are crushed and

† **2:5** or, sulfur

made subject to our enemies, and have become weak and powerless.
14 In our low condition, this bold and profane man seeks to dishonor this your holy place, consecrated out of the earth to the name of your Majesty.
15 Your dwelling place, the heaven of heavens, is indeed unapproachable to men.
16 But since it seemed good to you to exhibit your glory among your people Israel, you sanctified this place.
17 Don't punish us by means of the uncleanness of their men, and don't chastise us by means of their profanity, lest the lawless ones should boast in their rage, and exult in exuberant pride of speech, and say,
18 'We have trampled upon the holy house, as idolatrous houses are trampled upon.'
19 Blot out our iniquities, do away with our errors, and show your compassion in this hour.
20 Let your mercies quickly go before us. Grant us peace, that the downcast and broken hearted may praise you with their mouth."
21 At that time God, who sees all things, who is beyond all Holy among the holy, heard that prayer, so suitable, and scourged the man who was greatly uplifted with scorn and insolence.
22 Shaking him back and forth as a reed is shaken with the wind, he threw him down on the pavement, powerless, with limbs paralyzed, and by a righteous judgment deprived of the ability to speak.
23 His friends and bodyguards, seeing the swift recompense which had suddenly overtaken him, struck with exceeding terror, and fearing that he would die, speedily removed him.
24 When in course of time he had come to himself, this severe punishment caused no repentance within him, but he departed with bitter threatenings.
25 He proceeded to Egypt, grew worse in wickedness through his previously mentioned companions in wine, who were lost to all goodness,
26 and not satisfied with countless acts of impiety, his audacity so increased that he raised evil reports there, and many of his friends, watching his purpose attentively, joined in furthering his will.
27 His purpose was to inflict a public stigma upon our race. Therefore he erected a stone pillar in the courtyard, and caused the following inscription to be engraved upon it:
28 "Entrance to this temple is to be refused to all those who would not sacrifice. All the Jews were to be registered among the slaves. Those who resisted are to be forcibly seized and put to death.
29 Those who are thus registered are to be marked on their persons by the ivy-leaf symbol of Dionysus, and to be reduced to these limited rights."
30 To do away with the appearance of hating them all, he had it written underneath, that if any of them should elect to enter the community of those initiated in the rites, these should have equal rights with the Alexandrians.
31 Some of those who were over the city, therefore, abhorring any approach to the city of piety, unhesitatingly gave in to the king, and expected to derive some great honor from a future connection with him.
32 A nobler spirit, however, prompted the majority to cling to their religious observances, and by paying money that they might live unmolested, these sought to escape the registration,
33 cheerfully looking forward to future aid, they abhorred their own apostates, considering them to be national foes, and depriving them of common fellowship and mutual help.

3

1 On discovering this, so incensed was the wicked king, that he no longer confined his rage to the Jews in Alexandria. Laying his hand more heavily upon those who lived in the country, he gave orders that they should be quickly collected into one place, and most cruelly deprived of their lives.

2 While this was going on, a hostile
rumor was uttered abroad by men who
had banded together to injure the Jewish
race. The pretext of their charge was that
the Jews kept them away from the
ordinances of the law.
3 Now the Jews always maintained a
feeling of unwavering loyalty toward the
kings,
4 yet, as they worshiped God and
observed his law, they made certain
distinctions, and avoided certain things.
Hence they appeared hateful to some
people,
5 although, as they adorned their
conversation with works of
righteousness, they had established
themselves in the good opinion of the
world.
6 What all the rest of mankind said was,
however, disregarded by the foreigners,
7 who said much of the exclusiveness of
the Jews with regard to their worship and
meats. They alleged that they were
unsociable men, hostile to the king's
interests, refusing to associate with him
or his troops. By this way of speaking,
they brought much hatred on them.
8 This unexpected uproar and sudden
gathering of people was observed by the
Greeks who lived in the city, concerning
men who had never harmed them. Yet to
aid them was not in their power, since all
was oppression around, but they
encouraged them in their troubles, and
expected a favorable turn of affairs.
9 He who knows all things will not, they
said, disregard so great a people.
10 Some of the neighbors, friends, and
business associates of the Jews even called
them secretly to an interview, pledged
them their assistance, and promised to do
their very utmost for them.
11 Now the king, elated with his
prosperous fortune, and not regarding
the superior power of God, but thinking to
persevere in his present purpose, wrote
the following letter to the prejudice of the
Jews:
12 "King Ptolemy Philopater, to the
commanders and soldiers in Egypt, and in
all places, health and happiness!
13 I am doing well, and so, too, are my
affairs.
14 Since our Asiatic campaign, the
particulars of which you know, and which
by the aid of the gods, not lightly given,
and by our own vigor, has been brought
to a successful conclusion according to
our expectation,
15 we resolved, not with strength of
spear, but with gentleness and much
humanity, as it were to nurse the
inhabitants of Coele-Syria and Phoenicia,
and to be their willing benefactors.
16 So, having bestowed considerable
sums of money upon the temples of the
several cities, we proceeded even as far as
Jerusalem, and went up to honor the
temple of these wretched beings who
never cease from their folly.
17 To outward appearance they received
us willingly, but belied that appearance
by their deeds. When we were eager to
enter their temple, and to honor it with
the most beautiful and exquisite gifts,
18 they were so carried away by their
old arrogance as to forbid us the entrance,
while we, out of our forbearance toward
all men, refrained from exercising our
power upon them.
19 Thus, exhibiting their enmity against
us, they alone among the nations lift up
their heads against kings and benefactors,
as men unwilling to submit to any
reasonable thing.
20 We then, having endeavored to make
allowance for the madness of these
people, and on our victorious return
treating all people in Egypt courteously,
acted in a manner which was befitting.
21 Accordingly, bearing no ill will
against their kinsmen, but rather
remembering our connection with them,
and the numerous matters with sincere
heart from a remote period entrusted to
them, we wished to venture a total
alteration of their state, by giving them
the rights of citizens of Alexandria, and to
admit them to the everlasting rites of our
solemnities.
22 All this, however, they have taken in a

very different spirit. With their innate malignity, they have spurned the fair offer, and constantly inclining to evil,
23 have rejected the inestimable rights. Not only so, but by using speech, and by refraining from speech, they abhor the few among them who are heartily disposed toward us, ever deeming that their infamous way of life will force us to do away with our reform.
24 Having then received certain proofs that these Jews bear us every sort of ill will, we must look forward to the possibility of some sudden tumult among ourselves when these impious men may turn traitors and barbarous enemies.
25 Therefore, as soon as the contents of this letter become known to you, in that same hour we order those Jews who dwell among you, with wives and children, to be sent to us, vilified and abused, in chains of iron, to undergo a cruel and shameful death, suitable to enemies.
26 For by the punishment of them in one body we perceive that we have found the only means of establishing our affairs for the future on a firm and satisfactory basis.
27 Whoever protects a Jew, whether it be old man, child, or nursing baby, shall with his whole house be tortured to death.
28 Whoever informs against the Jews, besides receiving the property of the person charged, shall be presented with two thousand drachmas† from the royal treasury, shall be made free, and shall be crowned.
29 Whatever place shelters a Jew shall be made unapproachable and shall be put under the ban of fire, and be forever rendered useless to every living being for all time to come."
30 The king's letter was written in the above form.

4

1 Wherever this decree was received, the people kept up a revelry of joy and shouting, as if their long-pent-up, hardened hatred would now show itself openly.
2 The Jews suffered great throes of sorrow and wept much, while their hearts, all things around being lamentable, were set on fire as they bewailed the sudden destruction which was decreed against them.
3 What home, or city, or any inhabited place, or what streets were there, which their condition didn't fill with wailing and lamentation?
4 They were sent out unanimously by the generals in various cities, with such stern and pitiless feeling that the exceptional nature of the infliction moved even some of their enemies. These, influenced by sentiments of common humanity, and reflecting upon the uncertain issue of life, shed tears at their miserable expulsion.
5 A multitude of aged hoary-haired old men were driven along with halting bending feet, urged onward by the impulse of a violent, shameless force to quick speed.
6 Girls who had entered the bridal chamber quite lately, to enjoy the partnership of marriage, exchanged pleasure for misery; and with dust scattered upon their myrrh-anointed heads, were hurried along unveiled; and, in the midst of outlandish insults, set up with one accord a lamentable cry instead of the marriage hymn.
7 Bound and exposed to public gaze, they were hurried violently on board ship.
8 The husbands of these, in the prime of their youthful vigor, instead of crowns, wore ropes round their necks. Instead of feasting and youthful celebration, they spent the rest of their nuptial days in wailing, and saw only the grave at hand.
9 They were dragged along by unyielding chains, like wild animals. Of these, some had their necks thrust into the benches of the rowers, while the feet of others were enclosed in hard fetters.
10 The planks of the deck above them blocked out the light and shut out the day on every side, so that they might be treated like traitors during the whole

† **3:28** a drachma was about a day's pay for an agricultural laborer

voyage.

11 They were carried like this in this vessel, and at the end of it arrived at Schedia. The king had ordered them to be cast into the vast hippodrome, which was built in front of the city. This place was well adapted by its situation to expose them to the gaze of all comers into the city, and of those who went from the city into the country. Thus they could hold no communication with his forces. They weren't deemed worthy of any civilized accommodation.
12 When this was done, the king, hearing that their kindred in the city often went out and lamented the melancholy distress of these victims,
13 was full of rage, and commanded that they should be carefully subjected to the same—and not one bit milder—treatment.
14 The whole nation was now to be registered. Every individual was to be specified by name, not for that hard servitude of labor which we have a little before mentioned, but that he might expose them to the before-mentioned tortures; and finally, in the short space of a day, might exterminate them by his cruelties.
15 The registering of these men was carried on cruelly, zealously, assiduously, from the rising of the sun to its going down, and was not brought to an end in forty days.
16 The king was filled with great and constant joy, and celebrated banquets before the temple idols. His erring heart, far from the truth, and his profane mouth gave glory to idols, deaf and incapable of speaking or aiding, and uttered unworthy speech against the Greatest God.
17 At the end of the above-mentioned interval of time, the registrars brought word to the king that the multitude of the Jews was too great for registration,
18 inasmuch as there were many still left in the land, of whom some were in inhabited houses, and others were scattered about in various places, so that all the commanders in Egypt were insufficient for the work.
19 The king threatened them, and charged them with taking bribes, in order to contrive the escape of the Jews, but was clearly convinced of the truth of what had been said.
20 They said, and proved, that paper and pens had failed them for the carrying out of their purpose.
21 Now this was an active interference of the unconquerable Providence which assisted the Jews from heaven.

5

1 Then he called Hermon, who had charge of the elephants. Full of rage, altogether fixed in his furious design,
2 he commanded him, with a quantity of unmixed wine with handfuls of incense infused, to drug the elephants early on the following day. These five hundred elephants were, when infuriated by the copious drinks of frankincense, to be led up to the execution of death upon the Jews.
3 The king, after issuing these orders, went to his feasting, and gathered together all those of his friends and of the army who hated the Jews the most.
4 The master of the elephants, Hermon, fulfilled his commission punctually.
5 The servants appointed for the purpose went out about evening and bound the hands of the miserable victims, and took other precautions for their security at night, thinking that the whole race would perish together.
6 The heathen believed the Jews to be destitute of all protection, for chains bound them.
7 They invoked the Almighty Lord, and ceaselessly implored with tears their merciful God and Father, Ruler of all, Lord of every power,
8 to overthrow the evil purpose which had gone out against them, and to deliver them by extraordinary manifestation from that death which was in store for them.
9 Their earnest entreaty went up to heaven.
10 Then Hermon, who had filled his merciless elephants with copious drinks

of mixed wine and frankincense, came early to the palace to report on these preparations.
11 He, however, who has sent his good creature sleep from all time by night or by day thus gratifying whom he wills, diffused a portion of it now upon the king.
12 By this sweet and profound influence of the Lord, he was held fast, and thus his unjust purpose was quite frustrated, and his unflinching resolve greatly falsified.
13 But the Jews, having escaped the hour which had been fixed, praised their holy God, and again prayed him who is easily reconciled to display the power of his powerful hand to the arrogant Gentiles.
14 The middle of the tenth hour had nearly arrived, when the person who sent invitations, seeing the guests who were invited present, came and shook the king.
15 He gained his attention with difficulty, and hinting that the mealtime was getting past, talked the matter over with him.
16 The king listened to this, and then turning aside to his drinking, commanded the guests to sit down before him.
17 This done, he asked them to enjoy themselves, and to indulge in mirth at this somewhat late hour of the banquet.
18 Conversation grew on, and the king sent for Hermon, and inquired of him, with fierce denunciations, why the Jews had been allowed to outlive that day.
19 Hermon explained that he had done his bidding over night; and in this he was confirmed by his friends.
20 The king, then, with a barbarity exceeding that of Phalaris, said, “They might thank his sleep of that day. Lose no time, and get ready the elephants against tomorrow, as you did before, for the destruction of these accursed Jews.”
21 When the king said this, the company present were glad, and approved. Then each man went to his own home.
22 They didn’t employ the night in sleep, but in contriving cruel mockeries for those deemed miserable.
23 The morning cock had just crowed, and Hermon, having harnessed the brutes, was stimulating them in the great colonnade.
24 The city crowds were collected together to see the hideous spectacle, and waited impatiently for the dawn.
25 The Jews, breathless with momentary suspense, stretched out their hands and prayed the Greatest God, in mournful strains, again to help them speedily.
26 The sun’s rays were not yet shining and the king was waiting for his friends when Hermon came to him, calling him out, and saying that his desires could now be realized.
27 The king, receiving him, was astonished at his unusual invitation. Overwhelmed with a spirit of oblivion about everything, inquired about the object of this earnest preparation.
28 But this was the working of that Almighty God who had made him forget all his purpose.
29 Hermon and all his friends pointed out the preparation of the animals. They are ready, O king, according to your own strict injunction.
30 The king was filled with fierce anger at these words, for, by the Providence of God regarding these things, his mind had become entirely confused. He looked hard at Hermon, and threatened him as follows:
31 “Your parents, or your children, were they here, would have given a large meal to these wild animals, not these innocent Jews, who have loyally served me and my forefathers.
32 Had it not been for familiar friendship, and the claims of your office, your life should have gone for theirs.”
33 Hermon, being threatened in this unexpected and alarming manner, was troubled in his eyes, and his face fell.
34 The friends, too, stole out one by one, and dismissed the assembled multitudes to their respective occupations.
35 The Jews, having heard of these events, praised the glorious God and King of kings, because they had obtained this help, too, from him.
36 Now the king arranged another

banquet in the same way, and proclaimed an invitation to mirth.
37 He summoned Hermon to his presence, and said, with threats, “How often, O wretch, must I repeat my orders to you about these same persons?
38 Once more, arm the elephants for the extermination of the Jews tomorrow!”
39 His kinsmen, who were reclining with him, wondered at his instability, and thus expressed themselves:
40 “O king, how long do you test us, as of men bereft of reason? This is the third time that you have ordered their destruction. When the thing is to be done, you change your mind, and recall your instructions.
41 Because of this, the feeling of expectation causes tumult in the city. It swarms with factions, and is continually on the point of being plundered.”
42 The king, just like another Phalaris, a prey to thoughtlessness, made no account of the changes which his own mind had undergone, issuing in the deliverance of the Jews. He swore a fruitless oath, and determined immediately to send them to hades, crushed by the knees and feet of the elephants.
43 He would also invade Judea, level its towns with fire and the sword, destroy that temple which the heathen might not enter, and prevent sacrifices ever after being offered up there.
44 Joyfully his friends broke up, together with his kinsmen; and, trusting in his determination, arranged their forces in guard at the most convenient places of the city.
45 The master of the elephants urged the animals into an almost maniacal state, drenched them with incense and wine, and decked them with frightful devices.
46 About early morning, when the city was filled with an immense number of people at the hippodrome, he entered the palace and called the king to the business in hand.
47 The king’s heart teemed with impious rage; and he rushed forth with the mass, along with the elephants. With unsoftened feelings and pitiless eyes, he longed to gaze at the hard and wretched doom of the previously mentioned Jews.
48 But the Jews, when the elephants went out at the gate, followed by the armed force. When they saw the dust raised by the throng, and heard the loud cries of the crowd,
49 thought that they had come to the last moment of their lives, to the end of what they had tremblingly expected. They gave way, therefore, to lamentations and moans. They kissed each other. Those nearest of kin to each other hung around one another’s necks—fathers hugging their sons and mothers their daughters. Other women held their infants to their breasts, which drew what seemed their last milk.
50 Nevertheless, when they reflected upon the help previously granted them from heaven, they prostrated themselves with one accord, removed even the sucking children from the breasts, and
51 sent up an exceedingly great cry asking the Lord of all power to reveal himself, and have mercy upon those who now lay at the gates of hades.

6

1 Then Eleazar, an illustrious priest of the country, who had attained to length of days, and whose life had been adorned with virtue, caused the elders who were around him to cease to cry out to the holy God, and prayed this:
2 “O king, mighty in power, most high, Almighty God, who regulates the whole creation with your tender mercy,
3 look at the seed of Abraham, at the children of the sanctified Jacob, your sanctified inheritance, O Father, now being wrongfully destroyed as foreigners in a foreign land.
4 You destroyed Pharaoh with his army of chariots when that lord of this same Egypt was uplifted with lawless daring and loud-sounding tongue. Shedding the beams of your mercy upon the race of Israel, you overwhelmed him and his proud army.

5 When Sennacherim, the grievous king
of the Assyrians, exulting in his countless
army, had subdued the whole land with
his spear and was lifting himself against
your holy city with boastings grievous to
be endured, you, O Lord, demolished him
and displayed your might to many
nations.
6 When the three friends in the land of
Babylon of their own will exposed their
lives to the fire rather than serve vain
things, you sent a moist coolness through
the fiery furnace, and brought the fire on
all their adversaries.
7 It was you who, when Daniel was
hurled, through slander and envy, as a
prey to lions down below, brought him
back again unharmed to light.
8 When Jonah was pining away in the
belly of the sea-born monster, you looked
at him, O Father, and recovered him to the
sight of his own.
9 Now, you who hate insolence, you who
abound in mercy, you who are the
protector of all things, appear quickly to
those of the race of Israel, who are
insulted by abhorred, lawless gentiles.
10 If our life during our exile has been
stained with iniquity, deliver us from the
hand of the enemy, and destroy us, O
Lord, by the death which you prefer.
11 Don't let the vain-minded
congratulate vain idols at the destruction
of your beloved, saying, 'Their god didn't
deliver them.'
12 You who are All-powerful and
Almighty, O Eternal One, behold! Have
mercy on us who are being withdrawn
from life, like traitors, by the unreasoning
insolence of lawless men.
13 Let the heathen cower before your
invincible might today, O glorious One,
who have all power to save the race of
Jacob.
14 The whole band of infants and their
parents ask you with tears.
15 Let it be shown to all the nations that
you are with us, O Lord, and have not
turned your face away from us, but as you
said that you would not forget them even
in the land of their enemies, so fulfill this
saying, O Lord."
16 Now, at the time that Eleazar had
ended his prayer, the king came along to
the hippodrome with the wild animals,
and with his tumultuous power.
17 When the Jews saw this, they uttered
a loud cry to heaven so that the adjacent
valleys resounded and caused an
irrepressible lamentation throughout the
army.
18 Then the all-glorious, all-powerful,
and true God, displayed his holy
countenance, and opened the gates of
heaven, from which two angels, dreadful
of form, came down and were visible to
all but the Jews.
19 They stood opposite, and filled the
enemies' army with confusion and
cowardice, and bound them with
immoveable shackles.
20 A cold shudder came over the person
of the king, and oblivion paralyzed the
vehemence of his spirit.
21 They turned back the animals on the
armed forces who followed them; and the
animals trampled them and destroyed
them.
22 The king's wrath was converted into
compassion; and he wept at the things he
had devised.
23 For when he heard the cry, and saw
them all on the verge of destruction, with
tears he angrily threatened his friends,
saying,
24 "You have governed badly, and have
exceeded tyrants in cruelty. You have
labored to deprive me, your benefactor, at
once of my dominion and my life, by
secretly devising measures injurious to
the kingdom.
25 Who has gathered here,
unreasonably removing each from his
home, those who, in fidelity to us, had
held the fortresses of the country?
26 Who has consigned to unmerited
punishments those who in good will
toward us from the beginning have in all
things surpassed all nations, and who
often have engaged in the most dangerous
undertakings?
27 Loose, loose the unjust bonds! Send
them to their homes in peace, begging

pardon for what has been done.
28 Release the sons of the almighty
living God of heaven, who from our
ancestors' times until now has granted a
glorious and uninterrupted prosperity to
our affairs."
29 He said these things, and they,
released the same moment, having now
escaped death, praised God their holy
Savior.
30 The king then departed to the city,
and called his financier to himself, and
asked him provide a seven days' quantity
of wine and other materials for feasting
for the Jews. He decided that they should
keep a cheerful festival of deliverance in
the very place in which they expected to
meet with their destruction.
31 Then they who were before despised
and near to hades, yes, rather advanced
into it, partook of the cup of salvation,
instead of a grievous and lamentable
death. Full of exultation, they
apportioned the place intended for their
fall and burial into banqueting booths.
32 Ceasing their miserable strain of woe,
they took up the subject of their
fatherland, singing in praise to God their
wonder-working Savior. All groans and
all wailing were laid aside. They formed
dances as a sign of peaceful joy.
33 So the king also collected a number of
guests for the occasion, and returned
unceasing thanks with much
magnificence for the unexpected
deliverance afforded him.
34 Those who had marked them out as
for death and for carrion, and had
registered them with joy, howled aloud,
and were clothed with shame, and had
the fire of their rage ingloriously put out.
35 But the Jews, as we just said,
instituted a dance, and then gave
themselves up to feasting, glad
thanksgiving, and psalms.
36 They made a public ordinance to
commemorate these things for
generations to come, as long as they
should be sojourners. They thus
established these days as days of mirth,
not for the purpose of drinking or luxury,
but because God had saved them.
37 They requested the king to send them
back to their homes.
38 They were being enrolled from the
twenty-fifth of Pachon to the fourth of
Epiphi, a period of forty days. The
measures taken for their destruction
lasted from the fifth of Epiphi till the
seventh, that is, three days.
39 The Ruler over all during this time
manifested his mercy gloriously, and
delivered them all together unharmed.
40 They feasted upon the king's
provision up to the fourteenth day, then
asked to be sent away.
41 The king commended them, and
wrote the following letter, of
magnanimous import for them, to the
commanders of every city:

7

1 "King Ptolemy Philopator to the
commanders throughout Egypt, and to all
who are set over affairs, joy and strength.
2 We, too, and our children are well.
God has directed our affairs as we wish.
3 Certain of our friends out of malice
vehemently urged us to punish the Jews
of our realm in a body, with the infliction
of a monstrous punishment.
4 They pretended that our affairs would
never be in a good state till this took place.
Such, they said, was the hatred borne by
the Jews to all other people.
5 They brought them fettered in
grievous chains as slaves, no, as traitors.
Without enquiry or examination they
endeavored to annihilate them. They
buckled themselves with a savage cruelty,
worse than Scythian custom.
6 For this cause we severely threatened
them; yet, with the clemency which we
usually extend to all men, we at length
permitted them to live. Finding that the
God of heaven cast a shield of protection
over the Jews so as to preserve them, and
that he fought for them as a father always
fights for his sons,
7 and taking into consideration their
constancy and fidelity toward us and
toward our ancestors, we have, as we

ought, acquitted them of every sort of charge.
8 We have dismissed them to their several homes, telling all men everywhere to do them no wrong, or unrighteously revile them about the past.
9 For know this, that should we conceive any evil design, or in any way aggrieve them, we shall ever have as our adversary, not man, but the highest God, the ruler of all might. From Him there will be no escape, as the avenger of such deeds. Farewell."
10 When they had received this letter, they didn't hurry to depart immediately. They petitioned the king to be allowed to inflict fitting punishment upon those of their race who had willingly transgressed the holy god, and the law of God.
11 They alleged that men who had for their bellies' sake transgressed the ordinances of God, would never be faithful to the interests of the king.
12 The king admitted the truth of this reasoning, and commended them. Full power was given them, without warrant or special commission, to destroy those who had transgressed the law of God boldly in every part of the king's dominions.
13 Their priests, then, as it was appropriate, saluted him with good wishes, and all the people echoed with the "Hallelujah!" Then they joyfully departed.
14 Then they punished and shamefully destroyed every polluted Jew that fell in their way,
15 slaying this way, in that day, more than three hundred men, and esteeming this destruction of the wicked a season of joy.
16 They themselves having held closely to their God to death, and having enjoyed a full deliverance, departed from the city garlanded with sweet-flowered wreaths of every kind. Uttering exclamations of joy, with songs of praise, and melodious hymns, they thanked the God of their fathers, the eternal Savior of Israel.
17 Having arrived at Ptolemais, called from the specialty of that district "Rose-bearing", where the fleet, in accordance with the general wish, waited for them seven days,
18 they partook of a banquet of deliverance, for the king generously granted them all the means of securing a return home.
19 They were accordingly brought back in peace, while they gave utterance to appropriate thanks; and they determined to observe these days during their sojourn as days of joyfulness.
20 These they registered as sacred upon a pillar, when they had dedicated the place of their festivity to be one of prayer. They departed unharmed, free, abundant in joy, preserved by the king's command, by land, by sea, and by river, each to his own home.
21 They had more weight than before among their enemies, and were honored and feared. No one in any way robbed them of their goods.
22 Every man received back his own, according to inventory, those who had obtained their goods, giving them up with the greatest terror. For the greatest God made perfect wonders for their salvation.
23 Blessed be the Redeemer of Israel forever! Amen.

The Second Book of Esdras

The Second Book of Esdras is included in the Slavonic Bible as *3 Esdras*, but is not found in the Greek Septuagint. It is included in the Appendix to the Latin Vulgate Bible as *4 Esdras*. It is considered to be Apocrypha by most church traditions. It is preserved here for its supplementary historical value.

1 The second book of the prophet Esdras,
the son of Saraias, the son of Azaraias, the
son of Helkias, the son of Salemas, the son
of Sadoc, the son of Ahitob,
2 the son of Achias, the son of Phinees,
the son of Heli, the son of Amarias, the son
of Aziei, the son of Marimoth, the son of
Arna, the son of Ozias, the son of Borith,
the son of Abissei, the son of Phinees, the
son of Eleazar,
3 the son of Aaron, of the tribe of Levi,
who was captive in the land of the Medes,
in the reign of Artaxerxes king of the
Persians.
4 The Lord's word came to me, saying,
5 "Go your way and show my people
their sinful deeds, and their children their
wickedness which they have done against
me, that they may tell their children's
children,
6 because the sins of their fathers have
increased in them, for they have forgotten
me, and have offered sacrifices to foreign
gods.
7 Didn't I bring them out of the land of
Egypt, out of the house of bondage? But
they have provoked me to wrath and have
despised my counsels.
8 So pull out the hair of your head and
cast all evils upon them, for they have not
been obedient to my law, but they are a
rebellious people.
9 How long shall I endure them, to
whom I have done so much good?
10 I have overthrown many kings for
their sakes. I have struck down Pharoah
with his servants and all his army.
11 I have destroyed all the nations
before them. In the east, I have scattered
the people of two provinces, even of Tyre
and Sidon, and have slain all their
adversaries.
12 Speak therefore to them, saying:

13 "The Lord says, truly I brought you
through the sea, and where there was no
path I made highways for you. I gave you
Moses for a leader and Aaron for a priest.
14 I gave you light in a pillar of fire. I
have done great wonders among you, yet
you have forgotten me, says the Lord.

15 "The Lord Almighty says: The quails
were for a token to you. I gave you a camp
for your protection, but you complained
there.
16 You didn't celebrate in my name for
the destruction of your enemies, but even
to this day you still complain.
17 Where are the benefits that I have
given you? When you were hungry and
thirsty in the wilderness, didn't you cry to
me,
18 saying, 'Why have you brought us
into this wilderness to kill us? It would
have been better for us to have served the
Egyptians than to die in this wilderness.'
19 I had pity on your mourning and gave
you manna for food. You ate angels'
bread.
20 When you were thirsty, didn't I split
the rock, and water flowed out in
abundance? Because of the heat, I
covered you with the leaves of the trees.
21 I divided fruitful lands among you. I
drove out the Canaanites, the Pherezites,
and the Philistines before you. What more
shall I do for you?" says the Lord.

22 The Lord Almighty says, "When you
were in the wilderness, at the bitter
stream, being thirsty and blaspheming
my name,
23 I gave you not fire for your
blasphemies, but threw a tree in the
water, and made the river sweet.
24 What shall I do to you, O Jacob? You,
Judah, would not obey me. I will turn
myself to other nations, and I will give my
name to them, that they may keep my
statutes.
25 Since you have forsaken me, I also
will forsake you. When you ask me to be

merciful to you, I will have no mercy upon you.
26 Whenever you call upon me, I will not hear you, for you have defiled your hands with blood, and your feet are swift to commit murder.
27 It is not as though you have forsaken me, but your own selves," says the Lord.

28 The Lord Almighty says, "Haven't I asked you as a father his sons, as a mother her daughters, and a nurse her young babies,
29 that you would be my people, and I would be your God, that you would be my children, and I would be your father?
30 I gathered you together, as a hen gathers her chicks under her wings. But now, what should I do to you? I will cast you out from my presence.
31 When you offer burnt sacrifices to me, I will turn my face from you, for I have rejected your solemn feast days, your new moons, and your circumcisions of the flesh.
32 I sent to you my servants the prophets, whom you have taken and slain, and torn their bodies in pieces, whose blood I will require from you," says the Lord.

33 The Lord Almighty says, "Your house is desolate. I will cast you out as the wind blows stubble.
34 Your children won't be fruitful, for they have neglected my commandment to you, and done that which is evil before me.
35 I will give your houses to a people that will come, which not having heard of me yet believe me. Those to whom I have shown no signs will do what I have commanded.
36 They have seen no prophets, yet they will remember their former condition.
37 I call to witness the gratitude of the people who will come, whose little ones rejoice with gladness. Although they see me not with bodily eyes, yet in spirit they will believe what I say."

38 And now, father, behold with glory, and see the people that come from the east:
39 to whom I will give for leaders, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, Oseas, Amos, and Micheas, Joel, Abdias, and Jonas,
40 Nahum, and Abacuc, Sophonias, Aggaeus, Zachary, and Malachy, who is also called the Lord's messenger.

2

1 The Lord says, "I brought this people out of bondage. I gave them my commandments by my servants the prophets, whom they would not listen to, but made my counsels void.
2 The mother who bore them says to them, 'Go your way, my children, for I am a widow and forsaken.
3 I brought you up with gladness, and I have lost you with sorrow and heaviness, for you have sinned before the Lord God, and done that which is evil before me.
4 But now what can I do for you? For I am a widow and forsaken. Go your way, my children, and ask for mercy from the Lord.'
5 As for me, O father, I call upon you for a witness in addition to the mother of these children, because they would not keep my covenant,
6 that you may bring them to confusion, and their mother to ruin, that they may have no offspring.
7 Let them be scattered abroad among the heathen. Let their names be blotted out of the earth, for they have despised my covenant.
8 Woe to you, Assur, you who hide the unrighteous with you! You wicked nation, remember what I did to Sodom and Gomorrah,
9 whose land lies in lumps of pitch and heaps of ashes. That is what I will also do to those who have not listened to me," says the Lord Almighty.

10 The Lord says to Esdras, "Tell my people that I will give them the kingdom of Jerusalem, which I would have given to Israel.
11 I will also take their glory back to myself, and give these the everlasting tabernacles which I had prepared for them.

12 They will have the tree of life for
fragrant perfume. They will neither labor
nor be weary.
13 Ask, and you will receive. Pray that
your days may be few, that they may be
shortened. The kingdom is already
prepared for you. Watch!
14 Call heaven and earth to witness. Call
them to witness, for I have left out evil,
and created the good, for I live, says the
Lord.
15 "Mother, embrace your children. I
will bring them out with gladness like a
dove does. Establish their feet, for I have
chosen you, says the Lord.
16 I will raise those who are dead up
again from their places, and bring them
out from their tombs, for I recognize my
name in them.
17 Don't be afraid, you mother of
children, for I have chosen you, says the
Lord.
18 For your help, I will send my servants
Esaias and Jeremy, after whose counsel I
have sanctified and prepared for you
twelve trees laden with various fruits,
19 and as many springs flowing with
milk and honey, and seven mighty
mountains, on which roses and lilies
grow, with which I will fill your children
with joy.
20 Do right to the widow. Secure justice
for the fatherless. Give to the poor.
Defend the orphan. Clothe the naked.
21 Heal the broken and the weak. Don't
laugh a lame man to scorn. Defend the
maimed. Let the blind man have a vision
of my glory.
22 Protect the old and young within your
walls.
23 Wherever you find the dead, set a
sign upon them and commit them to the
grave, and I will give you the first place in
my resurrection.
24 Stay still, my people, and take your
rest, for your rest will come.
25 Nourish your children, good nurse,
and establish their feet.
26 As for the servants whom I have given
you, not one of them will perish, for I will
require them from among your number.
27 Don't be anxious, for when the day of
suffering and anguish comes, others will
weep and be sorrowful, but you will
rejoice and have abundance.
28 The nations will envy you, but they
will be able to do nothing against you,
says the Lord.
29 My hands will cover you, so that your
children don't see Gehenna.†
30 Be joyful, mother, with your children,
for I will deliver you, says the Lord.
31 Remember your children who sleep,
for I will bring them out of the secret
places of the earth and show mercy to
them, for I am merciful, says the Lord
Almighty.
32 Embrace your children until I come,
and proclaim mercy to them, for my wells
run over, and my grace won't fail."
33 I, Esdras, received a command from
the Lord on Mount Horeb to go to Israel,
but when I came to them, they rejected me
and rejected the Lord's commandment.
34 Therefore I say to you, O nations that
hear and understand, "Look for your
shepherd. He will give you everlasting
rest, for he is near at hand who will come
at the end of the age.
35 Be ready for the rewards of the
kingdom, for the everlasting light will
shine on you forevermore.
36 Flee the shadow of this world, receive
the joy of your glory. I call to witness my
savior openly.
37 Receive that which is given to you by
the Lord, and be joyful, giving thanks to
him who has called you to heavenly
kingdoms.
38 Arise and stand up, and see the
number of those who have been sealed at
the Lord's feast.
39 Those who withdrew themselves
from the shadow of the world have
received glorious garments from the Lord.
40 Take again your full number, O Zion,
and make up the reckoning of those of
yours who are clothed in white, which
have fulfilled the law of the Lord.
41 The number of your children, whom
you long for, is fulfilled. Ask the power of

† **2:29** or, *Hell.*

the Lord, that your people, which have been called from the beginning, may be made holy."

42 I, Esdras, saw upon Mount Zion a great multitude, whom I could not number, and they all praised the Lord with songs.

43 In the midst of them, there was a young man of a high stature, taller than all the rest, and upon every one of their heads he set crowns, and he was more exalted than they were. I marveled greatly at this.

44 So I asked the angel, and said, "What are these, my Lord?"

45 He answered and said to me, "These are those who have put off the mortal clothing, and put on the immortal, and have confessed the name of God. Now they are crowned, and receive palms."

46 Then said I to the angel, "Who is the young man who sets crowns on them, and gives them palms in their hands?"

47 So he answered and said to me, "He is the Son of God, whom they have confessed in the world."

Then I began to praise those who stood so valiantly for the name of the Lord.

48 Then the angel said to me, "Go your way, and tell my people what kind of things, and how great wonders of the Lord God you have seen."

3

1 In the thirtieth year after the ruin of the city, I Salathiel, also called Esdras, was in Babylon, and lay troubled upon my bed, and my thoughts came up over my heart,

2 for I saw the desolation of Zion and the wealth of those who lived at Babylon.

3 My spirit was very agitated, so that I began to speak words full of fear to the Most High, and said,

4 "O sovereign Lord, didn't you speak at the beginning when you formed the earth—and that yourself alone—and commanded the dust

5 and it gave you Adam, a body without a soul? Yet it was the workmanship of your hands, and you breathed into him the breath of life, and he was made alive in your presence.

6 You led him into the garden which your right hand planted before the earth appeared.

7 You gave him your one commandment, which he transgressed, and immediately you appointed death for him and his descendants. From him were born nations, tribes, peoples, and kindred without number.

8 Every nation walked after their own will, did ungodly things in your sight, and despised your commandments, and you didn't hinder them.

9 Nevertheless, again in process of time, you brought the flood on those who lived in the world and destroyed them.

10 It came to pass that the same thing happened to them. Just as death came to Adam, so was the flood to these.

11 Nevertheless, you left one of them, Noah with his household, and all the righteous men who descended from him.

12 "It came to pass that when those who lived upon the earth began to multiply, they also multiplied children, peoples, and many nations, and began again to be more ungodly than their ancestors.

13 It came to pass, when they did wickedly before you, you chose one from among them, whose name was Abraham.

14 You loved, and to him only you showed the end of the times secretly by night,

15 and made an everlasting covenant with him, promising him that you would never forsake his descendants. To him, you gave Isaac, and to Isaac you gave Jacob and Esau.

16 You set apart Jacob for yourself, but rejected Esau. Jacob became a great multitude.

17 It came to pass that when you led his descendants out of Egypt, you brought them up to Mount Sinai.

18 You bowed the heavens also, shook the earth, moved the whole world, made the depths tremble, and troubled the age.

19 Your glory went through four gates, of fire, of earthquake, of wind, and of ice,

that you might give the law to the descendants of Jacob, and the commandment to the descendants of Israel.

20 "Yet you didn't take away from them their wicked heart, that your law might produce fruit in them.

21 For the first Adam, burdened with a wicked heart transgressed and was overcome, as were all who are descended from him.

22 Thus disease was made permanent. The law was in the heart of the people along with the wickedness of the root. So the good departed away and that which was wicked remained.

23 So the times passed away, and the years were brought to an end. Then you raised up a servant, called David,

24 whom you commanded to build a city to your name, and to offer burnt offerings to you in it from what is yours.

25 When this was done many years, then those who inhabited the city did evil,

26 in all things doing as Adam and all his generations had done, for they also had a wicked heart.

27 So you gave your city over into the hands of your enemies.

28 "Then I said in my heart, 'Are their deeds of those who inhabit Babylon any better? Is that why it gained dominion over Zion?'

29 For it came to pass when I came here, that I also saw impieties without number, and my soul saw many sinners in this thirtieth year, so that my heart failed me.

30 For I have seen how you endure them sinning, and have spared those who act ungodly, and have destroyed your people, and have preserved your enemies;

31 and you have not shown how your way may be comprehended. Are the deeds of Babylon better than those of Zion?

32 Or is there any other nation that knows you beside Israel? Or what tribes have so believed your covenants as these tribes of Jacob?

33 Yet their reward doesn't appear, and their labor has no fruit, for I have gone here and there through the nations, and I see that they abound in wealth, and don't think about your commandments.

34 Weigh therefore our iniquities now in the balance, and theirs also who dwell in the world, and so will it be found which way the scale inclines.

35 Or when was it that they who dwell on the earth have not sinned in your sight? Or what nation has kept your commandments so well?

36 You will find some men by name who have kept your precepts, but you won't find nations."

4

1 The angel who was sent to me, whose name was Uriel, gave me an answer,

2 and said to me, "Your understanding has utterly failed you regarding this world. Do you think you can comprehend the way of the Most High?"

3 Then I said, "Yes, my Lord."

He answered me, "I have been sent to show you three ways, and to set before you three problems.

4 If you can solve one for me, I also will show you the way that you desire to see, and I will teach you why the heart is wicked."

5 I said, "Say on, my Lord."

Then said he to me, "Go, weigh for me the weight of a fire, or measure for me a blast of wind, or call back for me the day that is past."

6 Then answered I and said, "Who of the sons of men is able to do this, that you should ask me about such things?"

7 He said to me, "If I had asked you, 'How many dwellings are there in the heart of the sea? Or how many springs are there at the fountain head of the deep? Or how many streams are above the firmament? Or which are the exits †of hell? Or which are the entrances of paradise?'

8 perhaps you would say to me, 'I never went down into the deep, or as yet into

† **4:7** So the Syriac. The Latin omits *of hell? or which are the paths.*

hell, neither did I ever climb up into heaven.'
9 Nevertheless now I have only asked you about the fire, wind, and the day, things which you have experienced, and from which you can't be separated, and yet you have given me no answer about them. "
10 He said moreover to me, "You can't understand your own things that you grew up with.
11 How then can your mind comprehend the way of the Most High? How can he who is already worn out with the corrupted world understand incorruption?"
‡When I heard these things, I fell on my face
12 and said to him, "It would have been better if we weren't here at all, than that we should come here and live in the midst of ungodliness, and suffer, and not know why."
13 He answered me, and said, §"A forest of the trees of the field went out, and took counsel together,
14 and said, 'Come! Let's go and make war against the sea, that it may depart away before us, and that we may make ourselves more forests.'
15 The waves of the sea also in like manner took counsel together, and said, 'Come! Let's go up and subdue the forest of the plain, that there also we may gain more territory.'
16 The counsel of the wood was in vain, for the fire came and consumed it.
17 Likewise also the counsel of the waves of the sea, for the sand stood up and stopped them.
18 If you were judge now between these two, which would you justify, or which would you condemn?"
19 I answered and said, "It is a foolish counsel that they both have taken, for the ground is given to the wood, and the place of the sea is given to bear its waves."
20 Then answered he me, and said, "You have given a right judgment. Why don't you judge your own case?
21 For just as the ground is given to the wood, and the sea to its waves, even so those who dwell upon the earth may understand nothing but what is upon the earth. Only he who dwells above the heavens understands the things that are above the height of the heavens."
22 Then answered I and said, "I beg you, O Lord, why has the power of understanding been given to me?
23 For it was not in my mind to be curious of the ways above, but of such things as pass by us daily, because Israel is given up as a reproach to the heathen. The people whom you have loved have been given over to ungodly nations. The law of our forefathers is made of no effect, and the written covenants are nowhere regarded.
24 We pass away out of the world like locusts. Our life is like a vapor, and we aren't worthy to obtain mercy.
25 What will he then do for his name by which we are called? I have asked about these things."
26 Then he answered me, and said, "If you are alive you will see, and if you live long, you will marvel, for the world hastens quickly to pass away.
27 For it is not able to bear the things that are promised to the righteous in the times to come; for this world is full of sadness and infirmities.
28 For the evil† about which you asked me has been sown, but its harvest hasn't yet come.
29 If therefore that which is sown isn't reaped, and if the place where the evil is sown doesn't pass away, the field where the good is sown won't come.
30 For a grain of evil seed was sown in the heart of Adam from the beginning, and how much wickedness it has produced to this time! How much more it will yet produce until the time of threshing comes!
31 Ponder now by yourself, how much fruit of wickedness a grain of evil seed has produced.

‡ **4:11** So the Syriac and Aethiopic. The Latin is corrupt. Judges 9:8. † **4:28** so the Syriac and Aethiopic. § **4:13** So the Oriental versions. The Latin is corrupt. See

32 When the grains which are without
number are sown, how great a threshing
floor they will fill!"
33 Then I answered and said, ‡"How
long? When will these things come to
pass? Why are our years few and evil?"
34 He answered me, and said, "Don't
hurry faster than the Most High; for your
haste is§ for your own self, but he who is
above hurries on behalf of many.
35 Didn't the souls of the righteous ask
about these things in their chambers,
saying, 'How long †will we be here? When
does the fruit of the threshing floor come?'
36 To them, Jeremiel the archangel
answered, 'When the number is fulfilled
of those who are like you. For he has
weighed the world in the balance.
37 By measure, he has measured the
times. By number, he has counted the
seasons. He won't ‡move or stir them until
that measure is fulfilled.' "
38 Then I answered, "O sovereign Lord,
all of us are full of ungodliness.
39 Perhaps it is for our sakes that the
threshing time of the righteous is kept
back—because of the sins of those who
dwell on the earth."
40 So he answered me, "Go your way to a
woman with child, and ask of her when
she has fulfilled her nine months, if her
womb may keep the baby any longer
within her."
41 Then I said, "No, Lord, that can it not."
He said to me, "In Hades, the chambers
of souls are like the womb.
42 For just like a woman in labor hurries
to escape the anguish of the labor pains,
even so these places hurry to deliver
those things that are committed to them
from the beginning.
43 Then you will be shown those things
which you desire to see."
44 Then I answered, "If I have found
favor in your sight, and if it is possible,
and if I am worthy,
45 show me this also, whether there is
more to come than is past, or whether the
greater part has gone over us.
46 For what is gone I know, but I don't
know what is to come."
47 He said to me, "Stand up on my right
side, and I will explain the parable to you."
48 So I stood, looked, and saw a hot
burning oven passed by before me. It
happened that when the flame had gone
by I looked, and saw that the smoke
remained.
49 After this, a watery cloud passed in
front of me, and sent down much rain
with a storm. When the stormy rain was
past, the drops still remained in it."
50 Then said he to me, "Consider with
yourself; as the rain is more than the
drops, and the fire is greater than the
smoke, so the quantity which is past was
far greater; but the drops and the smoke
still remained."
51 Then I prayed, and said, "Do you
think that I will live until that time? Or
who will be alive in those days?"
52 He answered me, "As for the signs
you asked me about, I may tell you of
them in part; but I wasn't sent to tell you
about your life, for I don't know.

5

1 "Nevertheless, concerning the signs,
behold, the days will come when those
who dwell on earth will be taken †with
great amazement, and the way of truth
will be hidden, and the land will be
barren of faith.
2 Iniquity will be increased above what
now you see, and beyond what you have
heard long ago.
3 The land that you now see ruling will
be a trackless waste, and men will see it
desolate.
4 But if the Most High grants you to live,
you will see troubles after the third
period. The sun will suddenly shine in the
night, and the moon in the day.
5 Blood will drop out of wood, and the
stone will utter its voice. The peoples will
be troubled, and the stars will fall.
6 He will rule whom those who dwell on
the earth don't expect, and the birds will
fly away together.

‡ **4:33** So the chief oriental versions. § **4:34** So the Syriac. The Latin is corrupt. † **4:35** So the Syriac. The Latin has *shall I hope on this fashion?* ‡ **4:37** Syr. *rest.* † **5:1** So the syriac.

7 The Sodomite sea will cast out fish, and
make a noise in the night, which many
have not known; but all will hear its voice.
8 There will also be chaos in many
places. Fires will break out often, and the
wild animals will change their places, and
women will bring forth monsters.
9 Salt waters will be found in the sweet,
and all friends will destroy one another.
Then reason will hide itself, and
understanding withdraw itself into its
chamber.
10 It will be sought by many, and won't
be found. Unrighteousness and lack of
restraint will be multiplied on earth.
11 One country will ask another, 'Has
righteousness, or a man that does
righteousness, gone through you?' And it
will say, 'No.'
12 It will come to pass at that time that
men will hope, but won't obtain. They will
labor, but their ways won't prosper.
13 I am permitted to show you such
signs. If you will pray again, and weep as
now, and fast seven days, you will hear
yet greater things than these."

14 Then I woke up, and an extreme
trembling went through my body, and my
mind was so troubled that it fainted.
15 So the angel who had come to talk
with me held me, comforted me, and set
me on my feet.

16 In the second night, it came to pass
that ‡Phaltiel the captain of the people
came to me, saying, "Where have you
been? Why is your face sad?
17 Or don't you know that Israel is
committed to you in the land of their
captivity?
18 Get up then, and eat some bread, and
don't forsake us, like a shepherd who
leaves the flock in the power of cruel
wolves."

19 Then said I to him, "Go away from me
and don't come near me for seven days,
and then you shall come to me." He heard
what I said and left me.

20 So I fasted seven days, mourning and
weeping, like Uriel the angel had
commanded me.
21 After seven days, the thoughts of my
heart were very grievous to me again,
22 and my soul recovered the spirit of
understanding, and I began to speak
words before the Most High again.
23 I said, "O sovereign Lord of all the
woods of the earth, and of all the trees
thereof, you have chosen one vine for
yourself.
24 Of all the lands of the world you have
chosen one §country for yourself. Of all
the flowers of the world, you have chosen
one lily for yourself.
25 Of all the depths of the sea, you have
filled one river for yourself. Of all built
cities, you have consecrated Zion for
yourself.
26 Of all the birds that are created you
have named for yourself one dove. Of all
the livestock that have been made, you
have provided for yourself one sheep.
27 Among all the multitudes of peoples
you have gotten yourself one people. To
this people, whom you loved, you gave a
law that is approved by all.
28 Now, O Lord, why have you given this
one people over to many, and †have
dishonored the one root above others,
and have scattered your only one among
many?
29 Those who opposed your promises
have trampled down those who believed
your covenants.
30 If you really do hate your people so
much, they should be punished with your
own hands."
31 Now when I had spoken these words,
the angel that came to me the night before
was sent to me,
32 and said to me, "Hear me, and I will
instruct you. Listen to me, and I will tell
you more."
33 I said, "Speak on, my Lord."

Then said he to me, "You are very
troubled in mind for Israel's sake. Do you

‡ **5:16** The Syriac has *Psaltiel.* § **5:24** After the Oriental versions. The Latin has *pit.* † **5:28** After the Oriental versions. The Latin reads *have prepared.*

love that people more than he who made them?"
34 I said, "No, Lord; but I have spoken out of grief; for my heart is in agony every hour while I labor to comprehend the way of the Most High, and to seek out part of his judgment."
35 He said to me, "You can't."
And I said, "Why, Lord? Why was I born? Why wasn't my mother's womb my grave, that I might not have seen the travail of Jacob, and the wearisome toil of the people of Israel?"
36 He said to me, "Count for me those who haven't yet come. Gather together for me the drops that are scattered abroad, and make the withered flowers green again for me.
37 Open for me the chambers that are closed, and bring out the winds for me that are shut up in them. Or show me the image of a voice. Then I will declare to you the travail that you asked to see."
38 And I said, "O sovereign Lord, who may know these things except he who doesn't have his dwelling with men?
39 As for me, I lack wisdom. How can I then speak of these things you asked me about?"
40 Then said he to me, "Just as you can do none of these things that I have spoken of, even so you can't find out my judgment, or the end of the love that I have promised to my people."
41 I said, "But, behold, O Lord, you have made the promise to those who are alive at the end. What should they do who have been before us, or we ourselves, or those who will come after us?"
42 He said to me, "I will compare my judgment to a ring. Just as there is no slowness of those who are last, even so there is no swiftness of those who be first."
43 So I answered, "Couldn't you make them all at once that have been made, and that are now, and that are yet to come, that you might show your judgment sooner?"
44 Then he answered me, "The creature may not move faster than the creator, nor can the world hold them at once who will be created in it."
45 And I said, "How have you said to your servant, that ‡you will surely make alive at once the creature that you have created? §If therefore they will be alive at once, and the creation will sustain them, even so it might now also support them to be present at once."
46 And he said to me, "Ask the womb of a woman, and say to her, 'If you bear ten children, why do you it at different times? Ask her therefore to give birth to ten children at once."
47 I said, "She can't, but must do it each in their own time."
48 Then said he to me, "Even so, I have given the womb of the earth to those who are sown in it in their own times.
49 For just as a young child may not give birth, neither she who has grown old any more, even so have I organized the world which I created."
50 I asked, "Seeing that you have now shown me the way, I will speak before you. Is our mother, of whom you have told me, still young? Or does she now draw near to old age?"
51 He answered me, "Ask a woman who bears children, and she will tell you.
52 Say to her, 'Why aren't they whom you have now brought forth like those who were before, but smaller in stature?'
53 She also will answer you, 'Those who are born in the strength of youth are different from those who are born in the time of old age, when the womb fails.'
54 Consider therefore you also, how you are shorter than those who were before you.
55 So are those who come after you smaller than you, as born of the creature which now begins to be old, and is past the strength of youth."
56 Then I said, "Lord, I implore you, if I have found favor in your sight, show your servant by whom you visit your creation."

6

1 He said to me, "In the beginning, when the earth was made, before the portals of

‡ **5:45** So the Syriac. § **5:45** The Latin omits *If...alive at once.*

the world were fixed and before the gatherings of the winds blew,
2 before the voices of the thunder sounded and before the flashes of the lightning shone, before the foundations of paradise were laid,
3 before the fair flowers were seen, before the powers of the earthquake were established, before the innumerable army of angels were gathered together,
4 before the heights of the air were lifted up, before the measures of the firmament were named, before the footstool of Zion †was established,
5 before the present years were reckoned, before the imaginations of those who now sin were estranged, and before they were sealed who have gathered faith for a treasure—
6 then I considered these things, and they all were made through me alone, and not through another; just as by me also they will be ended, and not by another."

7 Then I answered, "What will be the dividing of the times? Or when will be the end of the first and the beginning of the age that follows?"

8 He said to me, "From Abraham to Isaac, because Jacob and Esau were born to him, for Jacob's hand held Esau's heel from the beginning.
9 For Esau is the end of this age, and Jacob is the beginning of the one that follows.
10 ‡The beginning of a man is his hand, and the end of a man is his heel. Seek nothing else between the heel and the hand, Esdras!"

11 Then I answered, "O sovereign Lord, if I have found favor in your sight,
12 I beg you, show your servant the end of your signs which you showed me part on a previous night."

13 So he answered, "Stand up upon your feet, and you will hear a mighty sounding voice.
14 If the place you stand on is greatly moved
15 when it speaks don't be afraid, for the word is of the end, and the foundations of the earth will understand
16 that the speech is about them. They will tremble and be moved, for they know that their end must be changed."

17 It happened that when I had heard it, I stood up on my feet, and listened, and, behold, there was a voice that spoke, and its sound was like the sound of many waters.
18 It said, "Behold, the days come when I draw near to visit those who dwell upon the earth,
19 and when I investigate those who have caused harm unjustly with their unrighteousness, and when the affliction of Zion is complete,
20 and when the seal will be set on the age that is to pass away, then I will show these signs: the books will be opened before the firmament, and all will see together.
21 The children a year old will speak with their voices. The women with child will deliver premature children at three or four months, and they will live and dance.
22 Suddenly the sown places will appear unsown. The full storehouses will suddenly be found empty.
23 The trumpet will give a sound which when every man hears, they will suddenly be afraid.
24 At that time friends will make war against one another like enemies. The earth will stand in fear with those who dwell in it. The springs of the fountains will stand still, so that for three hours they won't flow.
25 "It will be that whoever remains after all these things that I have told you of, he will be saved and will see my salvation, and the end of my world.
26 They will see the men who have been taken up, who have not tasted death from their birth. The heart of the inhabitants will be changed and turned into a different spirit.
27 For evil will be blotted out and deceit will be quenched.

† **6:4** So the Syriac. ‡ **6:10** So the Syriac, etc. The Latin is defective.

28 Faith will flourish. Corruption will be
overcome, and the truth, which has been
so long without fruit, will be declared."
29 When he talked with me, behold, little
by little, the place I stood on §rocked back
and forth.
30 He said to me, "I came to show you
these things †tonight.
31 If therefore you will pray yet again,
and fast seven more days, I will ‡again tell
you greater things than these.
32 For your voice has surely been heard
before the Most High. For the Mighty has
seen your righteousness. He has also seen
your purity, which you have maintained
ever since your youth.
33 Therefore he has sent me to show you
all these things, and to say to you, 'Believe,
and don't be afraid!
34 Don't be hasty to think vain things
about the former times, that you may not
hasten in the latter times.' "
35 It came to pass after this, that I wept
again, and fasted seven days in like
manner, that I might fulfill the three
weeks which he told me.
36 On the eighth night, my heart was
troubled within me again, and I began to
speak in the presence of the Most High.
37 For my spirit was greatly aroused,
and my soul was in distress.
38 I said, "O Lord, truly you spoke at the
beginning of the creation, on the first day,
and said this: 'Let heaven and earth be
made,' and your word perfected the work.
39 Then the spirit was hovering, and
darkness and silence were on every side.
The sound of man's voice was not yet
there.§
40 Then you commanded a ray of light to
be brought out of your treasuries, that
your works might then appear.
41 "On the second day, again you made
the spirit of the firmament and
commanded it to divide and to separate
the waters, that the one part might go up,
and the other remain beneath.
42 "On the third day, you commanded
that the waters should be gathered
together in the seventh part of the earth.
You dried up six parts and kept them, to
the intent that of these some being both
planted and tilled might serve before you.
43 For as soon as your word went out,
the work was done.
44 Immediately, great and innumerable
fruit grew, with many pleasant tastes, and
flowers of inimitable color, and
fragrances of most exquisite smell. This
was done the third day.
45 "On the fourth day, you commanded
that the sun should shine, the moon give
its light, and the stars should be in their
order;
46 and gave them a command to serve
mankind, who was to be made.
47 "On the fifth day, you said to the
seventh part, where the water was
gathered together, that it should produce
living creatures, fowls and fishes; and so it
came to pass
48 that the mute and lifeless water
produced living things as it was told, that
the nations might therefore praise your
wondrous works.
49 "Then you preserved two living
creatures. The one you called Behemoth,
and the other you called Leviathan.
50 You separated the one from the other;
for the seventh part, namely, where the
water was gathered together, might not
hold them both.
51 To Behemoth, you gave one part,
which was dried up on the third day, that
he should dwell in it, in which are a
thousand hills;
52 but to Leviathan you gave the seventh
part, namely, the watery part. You have
kept them to be devoured by whom you
wish, when you wish.
53 "But on the sixth day, you
commanded the earth to produce before
you cattle, animals, and creeping things.
54 Over these, you ordained Adam as
ruler over all the works that you have
made. Of him came all of us, the people
whom you have chosen.

§ **6:29** After the Oriental versions. The Latin is corrupt. † **6:30** So the Syriac. The Latin is corrupt. ‡ **6:31** The Latin has *tell you by day.* § **6:39** The Latin adds *from you.*

55 “All this have I spoken before you, O
Lord, because you have said that for our
sakes you made †this world.
56 As for the other nations, which also
come from Adam, you have said that they
are nothing, and are like spittle. You have
likened the abundance of them to a drop
that falls from a bucket.
57 Now, O Lord, behold these nations,
which are reputed as nothing, being
rulers over us and devouring us.
58 But we your people, whom you have
called your firstborn, your only children,
and your fervent lover, are given into
their hands.
59 Now if the world is made for our
sakes, why don’t we possess our world for
an inheritance? How long will this
endure?”

7

1 When I had finished speaking these
words, the angel which had been sent to
me the nights before was sent to me.
2 He said to me, “Rise, Esdras, and hear
the words that I have come to tell you.”
3 I said, “Speak on, my Lord.”
Then he said to me, “There is a sea set in
a wide place, that it might be †broad and
vast,
4 but its entrance is set in a narrow
place so as to be like a river.
5 Whoever desires to go into the sea to
look at it, or to rule it, if he didn’t go
through the narrow entrance, how could
he come into the broad part?
6 Another thing also: There is a city built
and set in a plain country, and full of all
good things,
7 but its entrance is narrow, and is set in
a dangerous place to fall, having fire on
the right hand, and deep water on the left.
8 There is only one path between them
both, even between the fire and the water,
so that only one person can go there at
once.
9 If this city is now given to a man for an
inheritance, if the heir doesn’t pass the
danger before him, how will he receive
his inheritance?”
10 I said, “That is so, Lord.”
Then said he to me, “Even so also is
Israel’s portion.
11 I made the world for their sakes.
What is now done was decreed when
Adam transgressed my statutes.
12 Then the entrances of this world were
made narrow, sorrowful, and toilsome.
They are but few and evil, full of perils,
and involved in great toils.
13 For the entrances of the greater world
are wide and safe, and produce fruit of
immortality.
14 So if those who live don’t enter these
difficult and vain things, they can never
receive those that are reserved for them.
15 Now therefore why are you
disturbed, seeing you are but a
corruptible man? Why are you moved,
since you are mortal?
16 Why haven’t you considered in your
mind that which is to come, rather than
that which is present?”
17 Then I answered and said, “O
sovereign Lord, behold, you have
ordained in your law that the righteous
will inherit these things, but that the
ungodly will perish.
18 The righteous therefore will suffer
difficult things, and hope for easier things,
but those who have done wickedly have
suffered the difficult things, and yet will
not see the easier things.”
19 He said to me, “You are not a judge
above God, neither do you have more
understanding than the Most High.
20 Yes, let many perish who now live,
rather than that the law of God which is
set before them be despised.
21 For God strictly commanded those
who came, even as they came, what they
should do to live, and what they should
observe to avoid punishment.
22 Nevertheless, they weren’t obedient
to him, but spoke against him and
imagined for themselves vain things.
23 They made cunning plans of
wickedness, and said moreover of the
Most High that he doesn’t exist, and they
didn’t know his ways.

† **6:55** So the Syriac. The Latin has *the firstborn world.*

† **7:3** So the chief Oriental versions. The Latin MSS. have *deep.*

24 They despised his law and denied his
covenants. They haven't been faithful to
his statutes, and haven't performed his
works.
25 Therefore, Esdras, for the empty are
empty things, and for the full are the full
things.
26 For behold, the time will come, and it
will be, when these signs of which I told
you before will come to pass, that the
bride will appear, even the city coming
forth, and she will be seen who now is
withdrawn from the earth.
27 Whoever is delivered from the
foretold evils will see my wonders.
28 For my son Jesus will be revealed with
those who are with him, and those who
remain will rejoice four hundred years.
29 After these years my son Christ‡ will
die, along with all of those who have the
breath of life§.
30 Then the world will be turned into the
old silence seven days, like as in the first
beginning, so that no human will remain.
31 After seven days the world that is not
yet awake will be raised up, and what is
corruptible will die.
32 The earth will restore those who are
asleep in it, and the dust those who dwell
in it in silence, and the †secret places will
deliver those souls that were committed
to them.
33 The Most High will be revealed on the
judgment seat, ‡and compassion will pass
away, and patience will be withdrawn.
34 Only judgment will remain. Truth
will stand. Faith will grow strong.
35 Recompense will follow. The reward
will be shown. Good deeds will awake,
and wicked deeds won't sleep.§
36 The †pit of torment will appear, and
near it will be the place of rest. The
furnace of hell‡will be shown, and near it
the paradise of delight.
37 Then the Most High will say to the
nations that are raised from the dead,
'Look and understand whom you have
denied, whom you haven't served, whose
commandments you have despised.
38 Look on this side and on that. Here is
delight and rest, and there fire and
torments.' Thus §he will speak to them in
the day of judgment.
39 This is a day that has neither sun, nor
moon, nor stars,
40 neither cloud, nor thunder, nor
lightning, neither wind, nor water, nor
air, neither darkness, nor evening, nor
morning,
41 neither summer, nor spring, nor heat,
nor† winter, neither frost, nor cold, nor
hail, nor rain, nor dew,
42 neither noon, nor night, nor dawn,
neither shining, nor brightness, nor light,
except only the splendor of the glory of
the Most High, by which all will see the
things that are set before them.
43 It will endure as though it were a
week of years.
44 This is my judgment and its
prescribed order; but I have only shown
these things to you."
45 I answered, "I said then, O Lord, and I
say now: Blessed are those who are now
alive and keep your commandments!
46 But what about those for whom I
prayed? For who is there of those who are
alive who has not sinned, and who of the
children of men hasn't transgressed your
covenant?
47 Now I see that the world to come will
bring delight to few, but torments to
many.
48 For an evil heart has grown up in us,
which has led us astray from these
commandments and has brought us into
corruption and into the ways of death. It
has shown us the paths of perdition and
removed us far from life—and that, not a
few only, but nearly all who have been
created."
49 He answered me, "Listen to me, and I
will instruct you. I will admonish you yet
again.

‡ **7:29** "Christ" means "Anointed One". § **7:29** Latin *man* † **7:32** Or, *chambers* See 2 Esdras 4:35. ‡ **7:33** The Syriac adds *and the end will come.* § **7:35** The passage from verse [36] to verse [105], formerly missing, has been restored to the text. See Preface, page ix. † **7:36** So the chief Oriental versions. The Latin MSS. have *place.* ‡ **7:36** Latin *Gehenna.* § **7:38** So the chief Oriental versions. The Latin has *will you speak.* † **7:41** Or, *storm*

50 For this reason, the Most High has not made one world, but two.
51 For because you have said that the just are not many, but few, and the ungodly abound, hear the explanation.
52 If you have just a few precious stones, will you add them to lead and clay?"

53 I said, "Lord, how could that be?"

54 He said to me, "Not only that, but ask the earth, and she will tell you. Defer to her, and she will declare it to you.
55 Say to her, 'You produce gold, silver, and brass, and also iron, lead, and clay;
56 but silver is more abundant than gold, and brass than silver, and iron than brass, and lead than iron, and clay than lead.'
57 Judge therefore which things are precious and to be desired, what is abundant or what is rare?"
58 I said, "O sovereign Lord, that which is plentiful is of less worth, for that which is more rare is more precious."

59 He answered me, "Weigh within yourself the things that you have thought, for he who has what is hard to get rejoices over him who has what is plentiful.
60 So also is the judgment which I have promised; for I will rejoice over the few that will be saved, because these are those who have made my glory to prevail now, and through them, my name is now honored.
61 I won't grieve over the multitude of those who perish; for these are those who are now like mist, and have become like flame and smoke; they are set on fire and burn hotly, and are extinguished."

62 I answered, "O earth, why have you produced, if the mind is made out of dust, like all other created things?
63 For it would have been better that the dust itself had been unborn, so that the mind might not have been made from it.
64 But now the mind grows with us, and because of this we are tormented, because we perish and we know it.
65 Let the race of men lament and the animals of the field be glad. Let all who are born lament, but let the four-footed animals and the livestock rejoice.
66 For it is far better with them than with us; for they don't look forward to judgment, neither do they know of torments or of salvation promised to them after death.
67 For what does it profit us, that we will be preserved alive, but yet be afflicted with torment?
68 For all who are born are defiled with iniquities, and are full of sins and laden with transgressions.
69 If after death we were not to come into judgment, perhaps it would have been better for us."
70 He answered me, "When the Most High made the world and Adam and all those who came from him, he first prepared the judgment and the things that pertain to the judgment.
71 Now understand from your own words, for you have said that the mind grows with us.
72 They therefore who dwell on the earth will be tormented for this reason, that having understanding they have committed iniquity, and receiving commandments have not kept them, and having obtained a law they dealt unfaithfully with that which they received.
73 What then will they have to say in the judgment, or how will they answer in the last times?
74 For how long a time has the Most High been patient with those who inhabit the world, and not for their sakes, but because of the times which he has foreordained!"
75 I answered, "If I have found grace in your sight, O Lord, show this also to your servant, whether after death, even now when every one of us gives up his soul, we will be kept in rest until those times come, in which you renew the creation, or whether we will be tormented immediately."

76 He answered me, "I will show you this also; but don't join yourself with those who are scorners, nor count yourself with those who are tormented.
77 For you have a treasure of works laid up with the Most High, but it won't be shown you until the last times.

78 For concerning death the teaching is:
When the decisive sentence has gone out
from the Most High that a man shall die,
as the spirit leaves the body to return
again to him who gave it, it adores the
glory of the Most High first of all.
79 And if it is one of those who have
been scorners and have not kept the way
of the Most High, and that have despised
his law, and who hate those who fear God,
80 these spirits won't enter into
habitations, but will wander and be in
torments immediately, ever grieving and
sad, in seven ways.
81 The first way, because they have
despised the law of the Most High.
82 The second way, because they can't
now make a good repentance that they
may live.
83 The third way, they will see the
reward laid up for those who have
believed the covenants of the Most High.
84 The fourth way, they will consider the
torment laid up for themselves in the last
days.
85 The fifth way, they will see the
dwelling places of the others guarded by
angels, with great quietness.
86 The sixth way, they will see how
immediately some of them will pass into
torment.
87 The seventh way, which is more
grievous than all the aforesaid ways,
because they will pine away in confusion
and be consumed with shame, and will be
withered up by fears, seeing the glory of
the Most High before whom they have
sinned while living, and before whom
they will be judged in the last times.
88 "Now this is the order of those who
have kept the ways of the Most High,
when they will be separated from their
mortal body.
89 In the time that they lived in it, they
painfully served the Most High, and were
in jeopardy every hour, that they might
keep the law of the lawgiver perfectly.
90 Therefore this is the teaching
concerning them:
91 First of all they will see with great joy
the glory of him who takes them up, for
they will have rest in seven orders.
92 The first order, because they have
labored with great effort to overcome the
evil thought which was fashioned
together with them, that it might not lead
them astray from life into death.
93 The second order, because they see
the perplexity in which the souls of the
ungodly wander, and the punishment
that awaits them.
94 The third order, they see the
testimony which he who fashioned them
gives concerning them, that while they
lived they kept the law which was given
them in trust.
95 The fourth order, they understand
the rest which, being gathered in their
chambers, they now enjoy with great
quietness, guarded by angels, and the
glory that awaits them in the last days.
96 The fifth order, they rejoice that they
have now escaped from that which is
corruptible, and that they will inherit that
which is to come, while they see in
addition the difficulty and the pain from
which they have been delivered, and the
spacious liberty which they will receive
with joy and immortality.
97 The sixth order, when it is shown to
them how their face will shine like the
sun, and how they will be made like the
light of the stars, being incorruptible from
then on.
98 The seventh order, which is greater
than all the previously mentioned orders,
because they will rejoice with confidence,
and because they will be bold without
confusion, and will be glad without fear,
for they hurry to see the face of him
whom in their lifetime they served, and
from whom they will receive their reward
in glory.
99 This is the order of the souls of the
just, as from henceforth is announced to
them. Previously mentioned are the ways
of torture which those who would not
give heed will suffer from after this."

100 I answered, "Will time therefore be
given to the souls after they are separated
from the bodies, that they may see what
you have described to me?"

101 He said, “Their freedom will be for
seven days, that for seven days they may
see the things you have been told, and
afterwards they will be gathered together
in their habitations.”
102 I answered, “If I have found favor in
your sight, show further to me your
servant whether in the day of judgment
the just will be able to intercede for the
ungodly or to entreat the Most High for
them,
103 whether fathers for children, or
children for parents, or kindred for
kindred, or kinsfolk for their next of kin,
or friends for those who are most dear.”
104 He answered me, “Since you have
found favor in my sight, I will show you
this also. The day of judgment is‡ a day of
decision, and displays to all the seal of
truth. Even as now a father doesn’t send
his son, or a son his father, or a master his
slave, or a friend him that is most dear,
that in his place he may understand, or
sleep, or eat, or be healed,
105 so no one will ever pray for another
in that day, neither will one lay a burden
on another, for then everyone will each
bear his own righteousness or
unrighteousness.”
106 I answered, “How do we now find
that first Abraham prayed for the people
of Sodom, and Moses for the ancestors
who sinned in the wilderness,
107 and Joshua after him for Israel in the
days of *Achan,
108 and Samuel §in the days of Saul, and
David for the plague, and Solomon for
those who would worship in the
sanctuary,
109 and Elijah for those that received
rain, and for the dead, that he might live,
110 and Hezekiah for the people in the
days of Sennacherib, and many others
prayed for many?
111 If therefore now, when corruption
has grown and unrighteousness
increased, the righteous have prayed for
the ungodly, why will it not be so then
also?”
112 He answered me, “This present
world is not the end. The full glory doesn’t
remain in it. Therefore those who were
able prayed for the weak.
113 But the day of judgment will be the
end of this age, and the beginning of the
immortality to come, in which corruption
has passed away,
114 intemperance is at an end, infidelity
is cut off, but righteousness has grown,
and truth has sprung up.
115 Then no one will be able to have
mercy on him who is condemned in
judgment, nor to harm someone who is
victorious.”
116 I answered then, “This is my first and
last saying, that it would have been better
if the earth had not produced Adam, or
else, when it had produced him, to have
restrained him from sinning.
117 For what profit is it for all who are in
this present time to live in heaviness, and
after death to look for punishment?
118 O Adam, what have you done? For
though it was you who sinned, the evil
hasn’t fallen on you alone, but on all of us
who come from you.
119 For what profit is it to us, if an
immortal time is promised to us, but we
have done deeds that bring death?
120 And that there is promised us an
everlasting hope, but we have most
miserably failed?
121 And that there are reserved
habitations of health and safety, but we
have lived wickedly?
122 And that the glory of the Most High
will defend those who have led a pure life,
but we have walked in the most wicked
ways of all?
123 And that a paradise will be revealed,
whose fruit endures without decay, in
which is abundance and healing, but we
won’t enter into it,
124 for we have lived in perverse ways?
125 And that the faces of those who have
practiced self-control will shine more
than the stars, but our faces will be
blacker than darkness?

‡ **7:104** The Latin has *a bold day in the days of Saul.*
* **7:107** Joshua 7:1
§ **7:108** So the Syriac and other versions. The Latin omits

126 For while we lived and committed iniquity, we didn't consider what we would have to suffer after death."
127 Then he answered, "This is the significance of the battle which humans born on the earth will fight:
128 if they are overcome, they will suffer as you have said, but if they get the victory, they will receive the thing that I say.
129 For this is the way that Moses spoke to the people while he lived, saying, 'Choose life, that you may live!'
130 Nevertheless they didn't believe him or the prophets after him, not even me, who have spoken to them.
131 Therefore there won't be such heaviness in their destruction, as there will be joy over those who are assured of salvation."
132 Then I answered, "I know, Lord, that the Most High is now called merciful, in that he has mercy upon those who have not yet come into the world;
133 and compassionate, in that he has compassion upon those who turn to his law;
134 and patient, in that he is patient with those who have sinned, since they are his creatures;
135 and bountiful, in that he is ready to give rather than to take away;
136 and very merciful, in that he multiplies more and more mercies to those who are present, and who are past, and also to those who are to come—
137 for if he wasn't merciful, the world wouldn't continue with those who dwell in it—
138 and one who forgives, for if he didn't forgive out of his goodness, that those who have committed iniquities might be relieved of them, not even one ten thousandth part of mankind would remain living;
139 and a judge, for if he didn't pardon those who were created by his word, and blot out the multitude of sins,
140 there would perhaps be very few left of an innumerable multitude."

8

1 He answered me, "The Most High has made this world for many, but the world to come for few.
2 Now I will tell you a parable, Esdras. Just as when you ask the earth, it will say to you that it gives very much clay from which earthen vessels are made, but little dust that gold comes from. Even so is the course of the present world.
3 Many have been created, but few will be saved."
4 I answered, "Drink your fill of understanding then, O my soul, and let my heart devour wisdom.
5 For you †have come here apart from your will, and depart against your will, for you have only been given a short time to live.
6 O Lord over us, grant to your servant that we may pray before you, and give us seed for our heart and cultivation for our understanding, that fruit may grow from it, by which everyone who is corrupt, who bears the ‡likeness of a man, may live.
7 For you alone exist, and we all one workmanship of your hands, just as you have said.
8 Because you give life to the body that is now fashioned in the womb, and give it members, your creature is preserved in fire and water, and your workmanship endures nine months as your creation which is created in it.
9 But that which keeps and that which is kept will both be kept §by your keeping. When the womb gives up again what has grown in it,
10 you have commanded that out of the parts of the body, that is to say, out of the breasts, be given milk, which is the fruit of the breasts,
11 that the body that is fashioned may be nourished for a time, and afterwards you guide it in your mercy.
12 Yes, you have brought it up in your righteousness, nurtured it in your law, and corrected it with your judgment.
13 You put it to death as your creation, and make it live as your work.

† **8:5** So the Syriac. The Latin is incorrect. ‡ **8:6** So the Syriac. The Latin has *place.* § **8:9** So the Syriac. The Latin is imperfect.

14 If therefore you †lightly and suddenly
destroy him which with so great labor
was fashioned by your commandment, to
what purpose was he made?
15 Now therefore I will speak. About
man in general, you know best, but about
your people for whose sake I am sorry,
16 and for your inheritance, for whose
cause I mourn, for Israel, for whom I am
heavy, and for the seed of Jacob, for
whose sake I am troubled,
17 therefore I will begin to pray before
you for myself and for them; for I see the
failings of us who dwell in the land;
18 but I have heard the swiftness of the
judgment which is to come.
19 Therefore hear my voice, and
understand my saying, and I will speak
before you."
The beginning of the words of Esdras,
before he was taken up. He said,
20 "O Lord, you who remain forever,
whose eyes are exalted, and whose
chambers are in the air,
21 whose throne is beyond measure,
whose glory is beyond comprehension,
before whom the army of angels stand
with trembling,
22 ‡at whose bidding they are changed to
wind and fire, whose word is sure, and
sayings constant, whose ordinance is
strong, and commandment fearful,
23 whose look dries up the depths, and
whose indignation makes the mountains
to melt away, and whose truth bears
witness—
24 hear, O Lord, the prayer of your
servant, and give ear to the petition of
your handiwork.
25 Attend to my words, for as long as I
live, I will speak, and as long as I have
understanding, I will answer.
26 Don't look at the sins of your people,
but on those who have served you in
truth.
27 Don't regard the doings of those who
act wickedly, but of those who have kept
your covenants in affliction.
28 Don't think about those who have
lived wickedly before you, but remember
those who have willingly known your
fear.
29 Let it not be your will to destroy those
who have lived like cattle, but look at
those who have §clearly taught your law.
30 Don't be indignant at those who are
deemed worse than animals, but love
those who have always put their trust in
your glory.
31 For we and our fathers have †passed
our lives in ‡ways that bring death, but
you are called merciful because of us
sinners.
32 For if you have a desire to have mercy
upon us who have no works of
righteousness, then you will be called
merciful.
33 For the just, which have many good
works laid up with you, will be rewarded
for their own deeds.
34 For what is man, that you should take
displeasure at him? Or what is a
corruptible race, that you should be so
bitter toward it?
35 For in truth, there is no man among
those who are born who has not done
wickedly, and among those who have
lived, there is none which have not done
wrong.
36 For in this, O Lord, your
righteousness and your goodness will be
declared, if you are merciful to those who
have no store of good works."
37 Then he answered me, "Some things
you have spoken rightly, and it will
happen according to your words.
38 For indeed I will not think about the
fashioning of those who have sinned, or
about their death, their judgment, or their
destruction;
39 but I will rejoice over the creation of
the righteous and their pilgrimage, their
salvation, and the reward that they will
have.
40 Therefore as I have spoken, so it will
be.

† **8:14** So the Syriac. The Latin is incorrect. ‡ **8:22** According to the chief Oriental versions. The Latin has, even they *whose service takes the form of wind etc.* § **8:29** The Syriac has *received the brightness of your law.* † **8:31** So the Syriac and Aethiopic versions. ‡ **8:31** Latin *manners.*

41 For as the farmer sows many seeds in the ground, and plants many trees, and yet not all that is sown will §come up in due season, neither will all that is planted take root, even so those who are sown in the world will not all be saved."
42 Then I answered, "If I have found favor, let me speak before you.
43 If the farmer's seed doesn't come up because it hasn't received your rain in due season, or if it is ruined by too much rain and perishes,
44 likewise man, who is formed with your hands and is called your own image, because he is made like you, for whose sake you have formed all things, even him you have made like the farmer's seed.
45 Don't be angry with us, but spare your people and have mercy upon your inheritance, for you have mercy upon your own creation."
46 Then he answered me, "Things present are for those who live now, and things to come for those who will live hereafter.
47 For you come far short of being able to love my creature more than I. But you have compared yourself to the unrighteous. Don't do that!
48 Yet in this will you be admirable to the Most High,
49 in that you have humbled yourself, as it becomes you, and have not judged yourself among the righteous, so as to be much glorified.
50 For many grievous miseries will fall on those who dwell in the world in the last times, because they have walked in great pride.
51 But understand for yourself, and for those who inquire concerning the glory of those like you,
52 because paradise is opened to you. The tree of life is planted. The time to come is prepared. Plenteousness is made ready. A city is built. Rest is †allowed. Goodness is perfected, and wisdom is perfected beforehand.
53 The root of evil is sealed up from you. Weakness is done away from you, and ‡death is hidden. Hell and corruption have fled into forgetfulness.
54 Sorrows have passed away, and in the end, the treasure of immortality is shown.
55 Therefore ask no more questions concerning the multitude of those who perish.
56 For when they had received liberty, they despised the Most High, scorned his law, and forsook his ways.
57 Moreover they have trodden down his righteous,
58 and said in their heart that there is no God—even knowing that they must die.
59 For as the things I have said will welcome you, so thirst and pain which are prepared for them. For the Most High didn't intend that men should be destroyed,
60 but those who are created have themselves defiled the name of him who made them, and were unthankful to him who prepared life for them.
61 Therefore my judgment is now at hand,
62 which I have not shown to all men, but to you, and a few like you."
Then I answered,
63 "Behold, O Lord, now you have shown me the multitude of the wonders which you will do in the last times, but you haven't shown me when."

9

1 He answered me, "Measure diligently within yourself. When you see that a certain part of the signs are past, which have been told you beforehand,
2 then will you understand that it is the very time in which the Most High will visit the world which was made by him.
3 When earthquakes, tumult of peoples, plans of nations, wavering of leaders, and confusion of princes are seen in the world,
4 then will you understand that the Most High spoke of these things from the days that were of old, from the beginning.

§ **8:41** Latin *be saved.* † **8:52** The Syriac has *established.* ‡ **8:53** After the chief Oriental versions. † **9:5** So the Syriac. The Latin is corrupt.

5 For just as with everything that is
made in the world, the beginning †is
evident and the end manifest,
6 so also are the times of the Most High:
the beginnings are manifest in wonders
and mighty works, and the end in effects
and signs.
7 Everyone who will be saved, and will
be able to escape by his works, or by faith
by which they have believed,
8 will be preserved from the said perils,
and will see my salvation in my land and
within my borders, which I have
sanctified for myself from the beginning.
9 Then those who now have abused my
ways will be amazed. Those who have
cast them away despitefully will live in
torments.
10 For as many as in their life have
received benefits, and yet have not known
me,
11 and as many as have scorned my law,
while they still had liberty and when an
opportunity to repent was open to them,
didn't understand, but despised ‡it,
12 must know §it in torment after death.
13 Therefore don't be curious any longer
how the ungodly will be punished, but
inquire how the righteous will be saved,
†those who the world belongs to, and for
whom the world was created."
14 I answered,
15 "I have said before, and now speak,
and will say it again hereafter, that there
are more of those who perish than of
those who will be saved,
16 like a wave is greater than a drop."
17 He answered me, "Just as the field is,
so also the seed. As the flowers are, so are
the colors. As the work is, so also is the
‡judgment on it. As is the farmer, so also is
his threshing floor. For there was a time
in the world
18 when I was preparing for those who
now live, before the world was made for
them to dwell in. Then no one spoke
against me,
19 for §no one existed. But now those
who are created in this world that is
prepared, both †with a table that doesn't
fail and a law which is unsearchable, are
corrupted in their ways.
20 So I considered my world, and
behold, it was destroyed, and my earth,
and behold, it was in peril, because of the
plans that had come into it.
21 I saw and spared them, but not
greatly, and saved myself a grape out of a
cluster, and a plant out of ‡a great forest.
22 Let the multitude perish then, which
were born in vain. Let my grape be saved,
and my plant, for I have made them
perfect with great labor.
23 Nevertheless, if you will wait seven
more days—however don't fast in them,
24 but go into a field of flowers, where
no house is built, and eat only of the
flowers of the field, and you shall taste no
flesh, and shall drink no wine, but shall
eat flowers only—
25 and pray to the Most High continually,
then I will come and talk with you."
26 So I went my way, just as he
commanded me, into the field which is
called §Ardat. There I sat among the
flowers, and ate of the herbs of the field,
and this food satisfied me.
27 It came to pass after seven days that I
lay on the grass, and my heart was
troubled again, like before.
28 My mouth was opened, and I began to
speak before the Lord Most High, and
said,
29 "O Lord, you showed yourself among
us, to our fathers in the wilderness, when
they went out of Egypt, and when they
came into the wilderness, where no man
treads and that bears no fruit.
30 You said, 'Hear me, O Israel. Heed my
words, O seed of Jacob.
31 For behold, I sow my law in you, and
it will bring forth fruit in you, and you
will be glorified in it forever.'
32 But our fathers, who received the law,

‡ **9:11** Or, me § **9:12** Or, me † **9:13** So the Syriac and other versions. The Latin has *and whose... created, and when.* ‡ **9:17** So the Aethiopic and Arabic. The Latin has *creation.* § **9:19** So the Syriac. † **9:19** So the Syriac. ‡ **9:21** So the Syriac and other versions. The Latin has *great tribes.* § **9:26** The Syriac and Aethiopic have *Arphad.*

didn't keep it, and didn't observe the statutes. The fruit of the law didn't perish, for it couldn't, because it was yours.
33 Yet those who received it perished, because they didn't keep the thing that was sown in them.
34 Behold, it is a custom that when the ground has received seed, or the sea a ship, or any vessel food or drink, and when it comes to pass that that which is sown, or that which is launched,
35 or the things which have been received, should come to an end, these come to an end, but the receptacles remain. Yet with us, it doesn't happen that way.
36 For we who have received the law will perish by sin, along with our heart which received it.
37 Notwithstanding the law doesn't perish, but remains in its honor."
38 When I spoke these things in my heart, I looked around me with my eyes, and on my right side I saw a woman, and behold, she mourned and wept with a loud voice, and was much grieved in mind. Her clothes were torn, and she had ashes on her head.
39 Then let I my thoughts go in which I was occupied, and turned myself to her,
40 and said to her, "Why are you weeping? Why are you grieved in your mind?"
41 She said to me, "Leave me alone, my Lord, that I may weep for myself and add to my sorrow, for I am very troubled in my mind, and brought very low."
42 I said to her, "What ails you? Tell me."
43 She said to me, "I, your servant, was barren and had no child, though I had a husband thirty years.
44 Every hour and every day these thirty years I made my prayer to the Most High day and night.
45 It came to pass after thirty years that God heard me, your handmaid, and saw my low estate, and considered my trouble, and gave me a son. I rejoiced in him greatly, I and my husband, and all my †neighbors. We gave great honor to the Mighty One.
46 I nourished him with great care.
47 So when he grew up, and I came to take him a wife, I made him a feast day.

10

1 "So it came to pass that when my son was entered into his wedding chamber, he fell down and died.
2 Then we all put out the lamps, and all my †neighbors rose up to comfort me. I remained quiet until the second day at night.
3 It came to pass, when they had all stopped consoling me, encouraging me to be quiet, then rose I up by night, and fled, and came here into this field, as you see.
4 Now I don't intend to return into the city, but to stay here, and not eat or drink, but to continually mourn and fast until I die."
5 Then I left the reflections I was engaged in, and answered her in anger,
6 "You most foolish woman, don't you see our mourning, and what has happened to us?
7 For Zion the mother of us all is full of sorrow, and much humbled.
8 ‡It is right now to mourn deeply, since we all mourn, and to be sorrowful, since we are all in sorrow, but you are mourning for one son.
9 Ask the earth, and she will tell you that it is she which ought to mourn for so many that grow upon her.
10 For out of her, all had their beginnings, and others will come; and, behold, almost all of them walk into destruction, and the multitude of them is utterly doomed.
11 Who then should mourn more, §she who has lost so great a multitude, or you, who are grieved but for one?
12 But if you say to me, 'My lamentation is not like the earth's, for I have lost the fruit of my womb, which I brought forth with pains, and bare with sorrows;'

† **9:45** Latin *townsmen.* † **10:2** Latin *townsmen.* ‡ **10:8** See the Oriental versions. The Latin is corrupt. § **10:11** So the Syriac.

13 but it is with the earth after the
manner of the earth. The multitude
present in it has gone as it came.
14 Then say I to you, 'Just as you have
brought forth with sorrow, even so the
earth also has given her fruit, namely,
people, ever since the beginning to him
who made her.'
15 Now therefore keep your sorrow to
yourself, and bear with a good courage
the adversities which have happened to
you.
16 For if you will acknowledge the
decree of God to be just, you will both
receive your son in time, and will be
praised among women.
17 Go your way then into the city to your
husband."
18 She said to me, "I won't do that. I will
not go into the city, but I will die here."
19 So I proceeded to speak further to
her, and said,
20 "Don't do so, but allow yourself to be
persuaded by reason of the adversities of
Zion; and be comforted by reason of the
sorrow of Jerusalem.
21 For you see that our sanctuary has
been laid waste, our altar broken down,
our temple destroyed,
22 our lute has been brought low, our
song is put to silence, our rejoicing is at an
end, the light of our candlestick is put out,
the ark of our covenant is plundered, our
holy things are defiled, and the name that
we are called is profaned. Our free men
are despitefully treated, our priests are
burned, our Levites have gone into
captivity, our virgins are defiled and our
wives ravished, our righteous men
carried away, our little ones betrayed, our
young men are brought into bondage, and
our strong men have become weak.
23 What is more than all, the seal of Zion
has now lost the seal of her honor, and is
delivered into the hands of those who
hate us.
24 Therefore shake off your great
heaviness, and put away from yourself
the multitude of sorrows, that the Mighty
One may be merciful to you again, and the
Most High may give you rest, even ease
from your troubles."
25 It came to pass while I was talking
with her, behold, her face suddenly began
to shine exceedingly, and her
countenance flashed like lightning, so that
I was very afraid of her, and wondered
what this meant.
26 Behold, suddenly she made a great
and very fearful cry, so that the earth
shook at the noise.
27 I looked, and behold, the woman
appeared to me no more, but there was a
city built, and a place shown itself from
large foundations. Then I was afraid, and
cried with a loud voice,
28 "Where is Uriel the angel, who came
to me at the first? For he has caused me to
fall into this great trance, and my end has
turned into corruption, and my prayer a
reproach!"
29 As I was speaking these words,
behold, the angel who had come to me at
first came to me, and he looked at me.
30 Behold, I lay as one who had been
dead, and my understanding was taken
from me. He took me by the right hand,
and comforted me, and set me on my feet,
and said to me,
31 "What ails you? Why are you so
troubled? Why is your understanding and
the thoughts of your heart troubled?"
32 I said, "Because you have forsaken
me; yet I did according to your words, and
went into the field, and, behold, I have
seen, and still see, that which I am not
able to explain."
33 He said to me, "Stand up like a man,
and I will instruct you."
34 Then I said, "Speak on, my Lord; only
don't forsake me, lest I die before my time.
35 For I have seen what I didn't know,
and hear what I don't know.
36 Or is my sense deceived, or my soul in
a dream?
37 Now therefore I beg you to explain to
your servant what this vision means."
38 He answered me, "Listen to me, and I
will inform you, and tell you about the
things you are afraid of, for the Most High
has revealed many secret things to you.
39 He has seen that your way is
righteous, because you are continually

sorry for your people, and make great lamentation for Zion.
40 This therefore is the meaning of the vision.
41 The woman who appeared to you a little while ago, whom you saw mourning, and began to comfort her,
42 but now you no longer see the likeness of the woman, but a city under construction appeared to you,
43 and she told you of the death of her son, this is the interpretation:
44 This woman, whom you saw, is Zion,† whom you now see as a city being built.
45 She told you that she had been barren for thirty years because there were three thousand years in the world in which there was no offering as yet offered in her.
46 And it came to pass after three thousand years that Solomon built the city and offered offerings. It was then that the barren bore a son.
47 She told you that she nourished him with great care. That was the dwelling in Jerusalem.
48 When she said to you, 'My son died when he entered into his marriage chamber, and that misfortune befell her,' this was the destruction that came to Jerusalem.
49 Behold, you saw her likeness, how she mourned for her son, and you began to comfort her for what has happened to her. These were the things to be opened to you.
50 For now the Most High, seeing that you are sincerely grieved and suffer from your whole heart for her, has shown you the brightness of her glory and the attractiveness of her beauty.
51 Therefore I asked you to remain in the field where no house was built,
52 for I knew that the Most High would show this to you.
53 Therefore I commanded you to come into the field, where no foundation of any building was.
54 For no human construction could stand in the place in which the city of the Most High was to be shown.
55 Therefore don't be afraid nor let your heart be terrified, but go your way in and see the beauty and greatness of the building, as much as your eyes are able to see.
56 Then will you hear as much as your ears may comprehend.
57 For you are more blessed than many, and are called by name to be with the Most High, like only a few.
58 But tomorrow at night you shall remain here,
59 and so the Most High will show you those visions in dreams of what the Most High will do to those who live on the earth in the last days."

So I slept that night and another, as he commanded me.

11

1 It came to pass the second night that I saw a dream, and behold, an eagle which had twelve feathered wings and three heads came up from the sea.
2 I saw, and behold, she spread her wings over all the earth, and all the winds of heaven blew on her, †and the clouds were gathered together against her.
3 I saw, and out of her wings there grew other wings near them; and they became little, tiny wings.
4 But her heads were at rest. The head in the middle was larger than the other heads, yet rested it with them.
5 Moreover I saw, and behold, the eagle flew with her wings to reign over the earth and over those who dwell therein.
6 I saw how all things under heaven were subject to her, and no one spoke against her—no, not one creature on earth.
7 I saw, and behold, the eagle rose on her talons, and uttered her voice to her wings, saying,
8 "Don't all watch at the same time. Let each one sleep in his own place and watch in turn;
9 but let the heads be preserved for the last."

† **10:44** So the Syriac and other versions. The Latin is incorrect.
† **11:2** So the chief Oriental versions. The Latin has only *and were gathered together.*

10 I saw, and behold, the voice didn't
come out of her heads, but from the midst
of her body.
11 I counted ‡her wings that were near
the others, and behold, there were eight of
them.
12 I saw, and behold, on the right side
one wing arose and reigned over all the
earth.
13 When it reigned, the end of it came,
and it disappeared, so that its place
appeared no more. The next wing rose up
and reigned, and it ruled a long time.
14 It happened that when it reigned, its
end came also, so that it disappeared, like
the first.
15 Behold, a voice came to it, and said,
16 "Listen, you who have ruled over the
earth all this time! I proclaim this to you,
before you disappear,
17 none after you will rule as long as
you, not even half as long."
18 Then the third arose, and ruled as the
others before, and it also disappeared.
19 So it went with all the wings one after
another, as every one ruled, and then
disappeared.
20 I saw, and behold, in process of time
the §wings that followed were set up on
the †right side, that they might rule also.
Some of them ruled, but in a while they
disappeared.
21 Some of them also were set up, but
didn't rule.
22 After this I saw, and behold, the
twelve wings disappeared, along with two
of the little wings.
23 There was no more left on the eagle's
body, except the three heads that rested,
and six little wings.
24 I saw, and behold, two little wings
divided themselves from the six and
remained under the head that was on the
right side; but four remained in their
place.
25 I saw, and behold, these ‡under wings
planned to set themselves up and to rule.
26 I saw, and behold, there was one set
up, but in a while it disappeared.
27 A second also did so, and it
disappeared faster than the first.
28 I saw, and behold, the two that
remained also planned between
themselves to reign.
29 While they thought about it, behold,
one of the heads at rest awakened, the one
that was in the middle, for that was
greater than the two other heads.
30 I saw how it joined the two other
heads with it.
31 Behold, the head turned with those
who were with it, and ate the two §under
wings that planned to reign.
32 But this head held the whole earth in
possession, and ruled over those who
dwell in it with much oppression. It had
stronger governance over the world than
all the wings that had gone before.
33 After this I saw, and behold, the head
also that was in the middle suddenly
disappeared, like the wings.
34 But the two heads remained, which
also reigned the same way over the earth
and over those who dwell in it.
35 I saw, and behold, the head on the
right side devoured the one that was on
the left side.
36 Then I heard a voice, which said to
me, "Look in front of you, and consider
the thing that you see."
37 I saw, and behold, something like a
lion roused out of the woods roaring. I
heard how he sent out a man's voice to the
eagle, and spoke, saying,
38 "Listen and I will talk with you. The
Most High will say to you,
39 'Aren't you the one that remains of
the four animals whom I made to reign in
my world, that the end of my times might
come through them?
40 The fourth came and overcame all the
animals that were past, and ruled the
world with great trembling, and the
whole extent of the earth with grievous
oppression. He lived on the earth such a
long time with deceit.
41 You have judged the earth, but not
with truth.

‡ **11:11** The Syriac has *her little wings, and, etc.* § **11:20** The Syriac has *little wings.* † **11:20** The Aethiopic has *left.* ‡ **11:25** The Syriac has *little wings.* § **11:31** The Syriac has *little wings.*

42 For you have afflicted the meek, you
have hurt the peaceful, you have hated
those who speak truth, you have loved
liars, destroyed the dwellings of those
who produced fruit, and threw down the
walls of those who did you no harm.
43 Your insolence has come up to the
Most High, and your pride to the Mighty.
44 The Most High also has looked at his
times, and behold, they are ended, and his
ages are fulfilled.
45 Therefore appear no more, you eagle,
nor your horrible wings, nor your evil
little wings, nor your cruel heads, nor
your hurtful talons, nor all your worthless
body,
46 that all the earth may be refreshed
and relieved, being delivered from your
violence, and that she may hope for the
judgment and mercy of him who made
her.' "

12

1 It came to pass, while the lion spoke
these words to the eagle, I saw,
2 and behold, the head that remained
disappeared, and †the two wings which
went over to it arose and set themselves
up to reign; and their kingdom was brief
and full of uproar.
3 I saw, and behold, they disappeared,
and the whole body of the eagle was
burned, so that the earth was in great fear.
Then I woke up because of great
perplexity of mind and great fear, and
said to my spirit,
4 "Behold, you have done this to me,
because you search out the ways of the
Most High.
5 Behold, I am still weary in my mind,
and very weak in my spirit. There isn't
even a little strength in me, because of the
great fear with which I was frightened
tonight.
6 Therefore I will now ask the Most High
that he would strengthen me to the end."
7 Then I said, "O sovereign Lord, if I
have found favor in your sight, and if I am
justified with you more than many others,
and if my prayer has indeed come up
before your face,
8 strengthen me then, and show me,
your servant, the interpretation and plain
meaning of this fearful vision, that you
may fully comfort my soul.
9 For you have judged me worthy to
show me the end of time and the last
events of the times."
10 He said to me, "This is the
interpretation of this vision which you
saw:
11 The eagle, whom you saw come up
from the sea, is the fourth kingdom which
appeared in a vision to your brother
Daniel.
12 But it was not explained to him, as I
now explain it to you or have explained it.
13 Behold, the days come that a kingdom
will rise up on earth, and it will be feared
more than all the kingdoms that were
before it.
14 Twelve kings will reign in it, one after
another.
15 Of those, the second will begin to
reign, and will reign a longer time than
others of the twelve.
16 This is the interpretation of the
twelve wings which you saw.
17 As for when you heard a voice which
spoke, not going out from the heads, but
from the midst of its body, this is the
interpretation:
18 That ‡after the time of that kingdom,
there will arise no small contentions, and
it will stand in peril of falling.
Nevertheless, it won't fall then, but will be
restored again to its former power.
19 You saw the eight under wings
sticking to her wings. This is the
interpretation:
20 That in it eight kings will arise, whose
times will be short and their years swift.
21 Two of them will perish when the
middle time approaches. Four will be kept
for a while until the time of the ending of
it will approach; but two will be kept to
the end.
22 You saw three heads resting. This is
the interpretation:

† **12:2** So the chief Oriental versions. ‡ **12:18** The Oriental versions have *in the midst of.* § **12:23** The Oriental versions have *kings*

23 In its last days, the Most High will
raise up three §kingdoms and renew
many things in them. They will rule over
the earth,
24 and over those who dwell in it, with
much oppression, more than all those
who were before them. Therefore they
are called the heads of the eagle.
25 For these are those who will
accomplish her wickedness, and who will
finish her last actions.
26 You saw that the great head
disappeared. It signifies that one of them
will die on his bed, and yet with pain.
27 But for the two that remained, the
sword will devour them.
28 For the sword of the one will devour
him that was with him, but he will also
fall by the sword in the last days.
29 You saw two under wings passing
†over to the head that is on the right side.
30 This is the interpretation: These are
they whom the Most High has kept to his
end. This is the brief reign that was full of
trouble, as you saw.
31 "The lion, whom you saw rising up
out of the forest, roaring, speaking to the
eagle, and rebuking her for her
unrighteousness, and all her words which
you have heard,
32 this is the anointed one, whom the
Most High has kept to the end ‡[of days,
who will spring up out of the seed of
David, and he will come and speak] to
them and reprove them for their
wickedness and unrighteousness, and
will §heap up before them their
contemptuous dealings.
33 For at first he will set them alive in his
judgment, and when he has reproved
them, he will destroy them.
34 For he will deliver the rest of my
people with mercy, those who have been
preserved throughout my borders, and he
will make them joyful until the coming of
the end, even the day of judgment, about
which I have spoken to you from the
beginning.
35 This is the dream that you saw, and
this is its interpretation.
36 Only you have been worthy to know
the secret of the Most High.
37 Therefore write all these things that
you have seen in a book, and put it in a
secret place.
38 You shall teach them to the wise of
your people, whose hearts you know are
able to comprehend and keep these
secrets.
39 But wait here yourself seven more
days, that you may be shown whatever it
pleases the Most High to show you." Then
he departed from me.
40 It came to pass, when all the people
†saw that the seven days were past, and I
had not come again into the city, they all
gathered together, from the least to the
greatest, and came to me, and spoke to
me, saying,
41 "How have we offended you? What
evil have we done against you, that you
have utterly forsaken us, and sit in this
place?
42 For of all the prophets, only you are
left to us, like a cluster of the vintage, and
like a lamp in a dark place, and like a
harbor for a ship saved from the tempest.
43 Aren't the evils which have come to
us sufficient?
44 If you will forsake us, how much
better had it been for us if we also had
been consumed in the burning of Zion!
45 For we are not better than those who
died there." Then they wept with a loud
voice. I answered them,
46 "Take courage, O Israel! Don't be
sorrowful, you house of Jacob;
47 for the Most High remembers you.
The Mighty has not forgotten you ‡forever.
48 As for me, I have not forsaken you. I
haven't departed from you; but I have
come into this place to pray for the
desolation of Zion, and that I might seek
mercy for the humiliation of your
sanctuary.
49 Now go your way, every man to his
own house, and after these days I will

† **12:29** So the Syriac. The Latin has *over the head.* ‡ **12:32** The words in brackets are added from the Syriac.
§ **12:32** The Syriac has *set in order.* † **12:40** So the Syriac. The Latin has *heard.* ‡ **12:47** So the Syriac.

come to you.”
50 So the people went their way into the
city, as I told them to do.
51 But I sat in the field seven days, as the
angel commanded me. In those days, I ate
only of the flowers of the field, and my
food was from plants.

13

1 It came to pass after seven days, I
dreamed a dream by night.
2 Behold, a wind arose from the sea that
moved all its waves.
3 I saw, and behold, †[this wind caused
to come up from the midst of the sea
something like the appearance of a man. I
saw, and behold,] that man ‡flew with the
clouds of heaven. When he turned his face
to look, everything that he saw trembled.
4 Whenever the voice went out of his
mouth, all who heard his voice melted,
like the §wax melts when it feels the fire.
5 After this I saw, and behold, an
innumerable multitude of people was
gathered together from the four winds of
heaven to make war against the man who
came out of the sea.
6 I saw, and behold, he carved himself a
great mountain, and flew up onto it.
7 I tried to see the region or place from
which the mountain was carved, and I
couldn’t.
8 After this I saw, and behold, all those
who were gathered together to fight
against him were very afraid, and yet they
dared to fight.
9 Behold, as he saw the assault of the
multitude that came, he didn’t lift up his
hand, or hold a spear or any weapon of
war;
10 but I saw only how he sent out of his
mouth something like a flood of fire, and
out of his lips a flaming breath, and out of
his tongue he shot out a storm of sparks.†
11 These were all mixed together: the
flood of fire, the flaming breath, and the
great storm, and fell upon the assault of
the multitude which was prepared to
fight, and burned up every one of them, so
that all of a sudden an innumerable
multitude was seen to be nothing but the
dust of ashes and the smell of smoke.
When I saw this, I was amazed.

12 Afterward, I saw the same man come
down from the mountain, and call to
himself another multitude which was
peaceful.
13 Many people came to him. Some of
them were glad. Some were sorry. Some
of them were bound, and some others
brought some of those as offerings. Then
through great fear I woke up and prayed
to the Most High, and said,
14 “You have shown your servant these
wonders from the beginning, and have
counted me worthy that you should
receive my prayer.
15 Now show me also the interpretation
of this dream.
16 For as I conceive in my
understanding, woe to those who will be
left in those days! Much more woe to
those who are not left!
17 For those who were not left will be in
heaviness,
18 understanding the things that are laid
up in the latter days, but not attaining to
them.
19 But woe to them also who are left,
because they will see great perils and
much distress, like these dreams declare.
20 Yet is it ‡better for one to be in peril
and to come into §these things, than to
pass away as a cloud out of the world, and
not to see the things that †will happen in
the last days.”

He answered me,
21 “I will tell you the interpretation of
the vision, and I will also open to you the
things about which you mentioned.
22 You have spoken of those who are left
behind. This is the interpretation:
23 He that will ‡endure the peril in that
time will protect those who fall into
danger, even those who have works and
faith toward the Almighty.

† **13:3** The words in brackets are added from the Syriac. ‡ **13:3** So the Syriac. The Latin has *grew strong* § **13:4** So the Syriac and other Oriental versions. † **13:10** So the Syriac and Arabic. ‡ **13:20** Latin *easier.* § **13:20** So the Syriac. † **13:20** So the Syriac. ‡ **13:23** So the Syriac.

24 Know therefore that those who are
left behind are more blessed than those
who are dead.
25 These are the interpretations of the
vision: Whereas you saw a man coming
up from the midst of the sea,
26 this is he whom the Most High has
been keeping for many ages, who by his
own self will deliver his creation. He will
direct those who are left behind.
27 Whereas you saw that out of his
mouth came wind, fire, and storm,
28 and whereas he held neither spear,
nor any weapon of war, but destroyed the
assault of that multitude which came to
fight against him, this is the
interpretation:
29 Behold, the days come when the Most
High will begin to deliver those who are
on the earth.
30 Astonishment of mind will come
upon those who dwell on the earth.
31 One will plan to make war against
another, city against city, place against
place, people against people, and
kingdom against kingdom.
32 It will be, when these things come to
pass, and the signs happen which I
showed you before, then my Son will be
revealed, whom you saw as a man
ascending.
33 It will be, when all the nations hear
his voice, every man will leave his own
land and the battle they have against one
another.
34 An innumerable multitude will be
gathered together, as you saw, desiring to
come and to fight against him.
35 But he will stand on the top of Mount
Zion.
36 Zion will come, and will be shown to
all men, being prepared and built, like you
saw the mountain carved without hands.
37 My Son will rebuke the nations which
have come for their wickedness, with
plagues that are like a storm,
38 and will rebuke them to their face
with their evil thoughts, and the torments
with which they will be tormented, which
are like a flame. He will destroy them
without labor by the law, which is like fire.
39 Whereas you saw that he gathered to
himself another multitude that was
peaceful,
40 these are the ten tribes which were
led away out of their own land in the time
of Osea the king, whom Salmananser the
king of the Assyrians led away captive,
and he carried them beyond the River,
and they were taken into another land.
41 But they made this plan among
themselves, that they would leave the
multitude of the heathen, and go out into
a more distant region, where mankind
had never lived,
42 that there they might keep their
statutes which they had not kept in their
own land.
43 They entered by the narrow passages
of the river Euphrates.
44 For the Most High then did signs for
them, and stopped the springs of the River
until they had passed over.
45 For through that country there was a
long way to go, namely, of a year and a
half. The same region is called §Arzareth.
46 Then they lived there until the latter
time. Now when they begin to come again,
47 the Most High stops the springs of the
River again, that they may go through.
Therefore you saw the multitude
gathered together with peace.
48 But those who are left behind of your
people are those who are found within my
holy border.
49 It will be therefore when he will
destroy the multitude of the nations that
are gathered together, he will defend the
people who remain.
50 Then he will show them very many
wonders."
51 Then I said, "O sovereign Lord,
explain this to me: Why have I seen the
man coming up from the midst of the
sea?"
52 He said to me, as no one can explore
or know what is in the depths of the sea,
even so no man on earth can see my Son,
or those who are with him, except in the
time of †his day.

§ **13:45** That is, *another land.* See Deuteronomy 29:28.

† **13:52** So the Oriental versions. The Latin omits *his.*

53 This is the interpretation of the
dream which you saw, and for this only
you are enlightened about this,
54 for you have forsaken your own
ways, and applied your diligence to mine,
and have searched out my law.
55 You have ordered your life in
wisdom, and have called understanding
your mother.
56 Therefore I have shown you this, for
there is a reward laid up with the Most
High. It will be, after another three days I
will speak other things to you, and declare
to you mighty and wondrous things."
57 Then I went out and passed into the
field, giving praise and thanks greatly to
the Most High because of his wonders,
which he did from time to time,
58 and because he governs the time, and
such things as happen in their seasons. So
I sat there three days.

14

1 It came to pass upon the third day, I sat
under an oak, and, behold, a voice came
out of a bush near me, and said, "Esdras,
Esdras!"
2 I said, "Here I am, Lord," and I stood
up on my feet.
3 Then he said to me, "I revealed myself
in a bush and talked with Moses when my
people were in bondage in Egypt.
4 I sent him, and †he led my people out
of Egypt. I brought him up to Mount Sinai,
where I kept him with me for many days.
5 I told him many wondrous things, and
showed him the secrets of the times and
the end of the seasons. I commanded him,
saying,
6 'You shall publish these openly, and
these you shall hide.'
7 Now I say to you:
8 Lay up in your heart the signs that I
have shown, the dreams that you have
seen, and the interpretations which you
have heard;
9 for you will be taken away from men,
and from now on you will live with my
Son and with those who are like you, until
the times have ended.
10 For the world has lost its youth, and
the times begin to grow old.
11 ‡For the age is divided into twelve
parts, and ten parts of it are already gone,
§even the half of the tenth part.
12 There remain of it two parts after the
middle of the tenth part.
13 Now therefore set your house in
order, reprove your people, comfort the
lowly among them, †and instruct those of
them who are wise, and now renounce
the life that is corruptible,
14 and let go of the mortal thoughts, cast
away from you the burdens of man, put
off now your weak nature,
15 lay aside the thoughts that are most
grievous to you, and hurry to escape from
these times.
16 For worse evils than those which you
have seen happen will be done after this.
17 For look how much the world will be
weaker through age, so much that more
evils will increase on those who dwell in
it.
18 For the truth will withdraw itself
further off, and falsehood will be near.
For now ‡the eagle which you saw in
vision hurries to come."
19 Then I answered and said, §"Let me
speak in your presence, O Lord.
20 Behold, I will go, as you have
commanded me, and reprove the people
who now live, but who will warn those
who will be born afterward? For the
world is set in darkness, and those who
dwell in it are without light.
21 For your law has been burned,
therefore no one knows the things that
are done by you, or the works that will be
done.
22 But if I have found favor before you,
send the Holy Spirit to me, and I will write
all that has been done in the world since
the beginning, even the things that were
written in your law, that men may be able
to find the path, and that those who would

† **14:4** Another reading is. *I.* ‡ **14:11** Verses 11, 12 are omitted in the Syriac. The Aethiopic has *For the age is divided into ten parts, and is come to the tenth: and half of the tenth remains. Now etc.* § **14:11** Latin *and.* † **14:13** The Latin alone omits *and...wise.* ‡ **14:18** So the Oriental versions. § **14:19** The Latin omits *I will speak.*

live in the latter days may live."

23 He answered me and said, "Go your
way, gather the people together, and tell
them not to seek you for forty days.
24 But prepare for yourself many
tablets, and take with you Sarea, Dabria,
Selemia, Ethanus, and Asiel, these five,
which are ready to write swiftly;
25 and come here, and I will light a lamp
of understanding in your heart which will
not be put out until the things have ended
about which you will write.
26 When you are done, some things you
shall publish openly, and some things you
shall deliver in secret to the wise.
Tomorrow at this hour you will begin to
write."

27 Then I went out, as he commanded
me, and gathered all the people together,
and said,
28 "Hear these words, O Israel!
29 Our fathers at the beginning were
foreigners in Egypt, and they were
delivered from there,
30 and received the law of life, which
they didn't keep, which you also have
transgressed after them.
31 Then the land of Zion was given to
you for a possession; but you yourselves
and your ancestors have done
unrighteousness, and have not kept the
ways which the Most High commanded
you.
32 Because he is a righteous judge, in
due time, he took from you what he had
given you.
33 Now you are here, and your kindred
are among you.
34 Therefore if you will rule over your
own understanding and instruct your
hearts, you will be kept alive, and after
death you will obtain mercy.
35 For after death the judgment will
come, when we will live again. Then the
names of the righteous will become
manifest, and the works of the ungodly
will be declared.
36 Let no one therefore come to me now,
nor seek me for forty days."

37 So I took the five men, as he
commanded me, and we went out into the
field, and remained there.
38 It came to pass on the next day that,
behold, a voice called me, saying, "Esdras,
open your mouth, and drink what I give
you to drink."
39 Then opened I my mouth, and behold,
a full cup was handed to me. It was full of
something like water, but its color was
like fire.
40 I took it, and drank. When I had
drunk it, my heart uttered understanding,
and wisdom grew in my chest, for my
spirit retained its memory.
41 My mouth was opened, and shut no
more.
42 The Most High gave understanding to
the five men, and they wrote by course
the things that were told them, in
†characters which they didn't know, and
they sat forty days. Now they wrote in the
day-time, and at night they ate bread.
43 As for me, I spoke in the day, and by
night I didn't hold my tongue.
44 So in forty days, ninety-four books
were written.
45 It came to pass, when the forty days
were fulfilled, that the Most High spoke to
me, saying, "The first books that you have
written, publish openly, and let the
worthy and unworthy read them;
46 but keep the last seventy, that you
may deliver them to those who are wise
among your people;
47 for in them is the spring of
understanding, the fountain of wisdom,
and the stream of knowledge."
48 I did so.

15

1 "Behold, speak in the ears of my
people the words of prophecy which I will
put in your mouth," says the Lord.
2 "Cause them to be written on paper,
for they are faithful and true.
3 Don't be afraid of their plots against
you. Don't let the unbelief of those who
speak against you trouble you.
4 For all the unbelievers will die in their
unbelief.

† **14:42** So the Oriental versions.

5 “Behold,” says the Lord, “I bring evils
on the whole earth: sword, famine, death,
and destruction.
6 For wickedness has prevailed over
every land, and their hurtful works have
reached their limit.
7 Therefore,” says the Lord,
8 “I will hold my peace no more
concerning their wickedness which they
profanely commit, neither will I tolerate
them in these things, which they wickedly
practice. Behold, the innocent and
righteous blood cries to me, and the souls
of the righteous cry out continually.
9 I will surely avenge them,” says the
Lord, “and will receive to me all the
innocent blood from among them.
10 Behold, my people are led like a flock
to the slaughter. I will not allow them now
to dwell in the land of Egypt,
11 but I will bring them out with a
mighty hand and with a high arm, and
will strike Egypt with plagues, as before,
and will destroy all its land.”

12 Let Egypt and its foundations mourn,
for the plague of the chastisement and the
punishment that God will bring upon it.
13 Let the farmers that till the ground
mourn, for their seeds will fail and their
trees will be ruined through the blight
and hail, and a terrible tempest.
14 Woe to the world and those who
dwell in it!
15 For the sword and their destruction
draws near, and nation will rise up
against nation to battle with weapons in
their hands.
16 For there will be sedition among men,
and growing strong against one another.
In their might, they won’t respect their
king or the chief of their great ones.
17 For a man will desire to go into a city,
and will not be able.
18 For because of their pride the cities
will be troubled, the houses will be
destroyed, and men will be afraid.
19 A man will have no pity on his
neighbors, but will assault their houses
with the sword and plunder their goods,
because of the lack of bread, and for great
suffering.
20 “Behold,” says God, “I call together all
the kings of the earth to stir up those who
are from the rising of the sun, from the
south, from the east, and Libanus, to turn
themselves one against another, and
repay the things that they have done to
them.
21 Just as they do yet this day to my
chosen, so I will do also, and repay into
their bosom.” The Lord God says:
22 “My right hand won’t spare the
sinners, and my sword won’t cease over
those who shed innocent blood on the
earth.
23 A fire has gone out from his wrath
and has consumed the foundations of the
earth and the sinners, like burnt straw.
24 Woe to those who sin and don’t keep
my commandments!” says the Lord.
25 “I will not spare them. Go your way,
you rebellious children! Don’t defile my
sanctuary!”
26 For the Lord knows all those who
trespass against him, therefore he will
deliver them to death and destruction.
27 For now evils have come upon the
whole earth, and you will remain in them;
for God will not deliver you, because you
have sinned against him.

28 Behold, a horrible sight appearing
from the east!
29 The nations of the dragons of Arabia
will come out with many chariots. From
the day that they set out, their hissing is
carried over the earth, so that all those
who will hear them may also fear and
tremble.
30 Also the Carmonians, raging in wrath,
will go out like the wild boars of the forest.
They will come with great power and join
battle with them, and will devastate a
portion of the land of the Assyrians with
their teeth.
31 Then the dragons will have the upper
hand, remembering their nature. If they
will turn themselves, conspiring together
in great power to persecute them,
32 then these will be troubled, and keep
silence through their power, and will turn
and flee.
33 From the land of the Assyrians, an
enemy in ambush will attack them and

destroy one of them. Upon their army will be fear and trembling, and indecision upon their kings.

34 Behold, clouds from the east, and from the north to the south! They are very horrible to look at, full of wrath and storm.
35 They will clash against one another. They will pour out a heavy storm on the earth, even their own storm. There will be blood from the sword to the horse's belly,
36 and to the thigh of man, and to the camel's hock.
37 There will be fearfulness and great trembling upon earth. They who see that wrath will be afraid, and trembling will seize them.
38 After this, great storms will be stirred up from the south, from the north, and another part from the west.
39 Strong winds will arise from the east, and will shut it up, even the cloud which he raised up in wrath; and the storm that was to cause destruction by the east wind will be violently driven toward the south and west.
40 Great and mighty clouds, full of wrath, will be lifted up with the storm, that they may destroy all the earth and those who dwell in it. They will pour out over every high and lofty one a terrible storm,
41 fire, hail, flying swords, and many waters, that all plains may be full, and all rivers, with the abundance of those waters.
42 They will break down the cities and walls, mountains and hills, trees of the forest, and grass of the meadows, and their grain.
43 They will go on steadily to Babylon and destroy her.
44 They will come to it and surround it. They will pour out the storm and all wrath on her. Then the dust and smoke will go up to the sky, and all those who are around it will mourn for it.
45 Those who remain will serve those who have destroyed it.

46 You, Asia, who are partaker in the beauty of Babylon, and in the glory of her person—
47 woe to you, you wretch, because you have made yourself like her. You have decked out your daughters for prostitution, that they might please and glory in your lovers, which have always lusted after you!
48 You have followed her who is hateful in all her works and inventions. Therefore God says,
49 "I will send evils on you: widowhood, poverty, famine, sword, and pestilence, to lay waste your houses and bring you to destruction and death.
50 The glory of your power will be dried up like a flower when the heat rises that is sent over you.
51 You will be weakened like a poor woman who is beaten and wounded, so that you won't be able to receive your mighty ones and your lovers.
52 Would I have dealt with you with such jealousy," says the Lord,
53 "if you had not always slain my chosen, exalting and clapping your hands, and talking about their dead when you were drunk?
54 "Beautify your face!
55 The reward of a prostitute will be in your bosom, therefore you will be repaid.
56 Just as you will do to my chosen," says the Lord, "even so God will do to you, and will deliver you to your adversaries.
57 Your children will die of hunger. You will fall by the sword. Your cities will be broken down, and all your people in the field will perish by the sword.
58 Those who are in the mountains will die of hunger, eat their own flesh, and drink their own blood, because of hunger for bread and thirst for water.
59 You, unhappy above all others, will come and will again receive evils.
60 In the passage, they will rush on the hateful city and will destroy some portion of your land, and mar part of your glory, and will return again to Babylon that was destroyed.
61 You will be cast down by them as stubble, and they will be to you as fire.
62 They will devour you, your cities, your land, and your mountains. They will

burn all your forests and your fruitful trees with fire.
63 They will carry your children away captive, and will plunder your wealth, and mar the glory of your face."

16

1 Woe to you, Babylon, and Asia! Woe to you, Egypt and Syria!
2 Put on sackcloth and garments of goats' hair, wail for your children and lament; for your destruction is at hand.
3 A sword has been sent upon you, and who is there to turn it back?
4 A fire has been sent upon you, and who is there to quench it?
5 Calamities are sent upon you, and who is there to drive them away?
6 Can one drive away a hungry lion in the forest? Can one quench a fire in stubble, once it has begun to burn?
7 Can one turn back an arrow that is shot by a strong archer?
8 The Lord God sends the calamities, and who will drive them away?
9 A fire will go out from his wrath, and who may quench it?
10 He will flash lightning, and who will not fear? He will thunder, and who wouldn't tremble?
11 The Lord will threaten, and who will not be utterly broken in pieces at his presence?
12 The earth and its foundations quake. The sea rises up with waves from the deep, and its waves will be troubled, along with the fish in them, at the presence of the Lord, and before the glory of his power.
13 For his right hand that bends the bow is strong, his arrows that he shoots are sharp, and will not miss when they begin to be shot into the ends of the world.
14 Behold, the calamities are sent out, and will not return again until they come upon the earth.
15 The fire is kindled and will not be put out until it consumes the foundations of the earth.
16 Just as an arrow which is shot by a mighty archer doesn't return backward, even so the calamities that are sent out upon earth won't return again.
17 Woe is me! Woe is me! Who will deliver me in those days?
18 The beginning of sorrows, when there will be great mourning; the beginning of famine, and many will perish; the beginning of wars, and the powers will stand in fear; the beginning of calamities, and all will tremble! What will they do when the calamities come?
19 Behold, famine and plague, suffering and anguish! They are sent as scourges for correction.
20 But for all these things they will not turn them from their wickedness, nor be always mindful of the scourges.
21 Behold, food will be so cheap on earth that they will think themselves to be in good condition, and even then calamities will grow on earth: sword, famine, and great confusion.
22 For many of those who dwell on earth will perish of famine; and others who escape the famine, the sword will destroy.
23 The dead will be cast out like dung, and there will be no one to comfort them; for the earth will be left desolate, and its cities will be cast down.
24 There will be no farmer left to cultivate the earth or to sow it.
25 The trees will give fruit, but who will gather it?
26 The grapes will ripen, but who will tread them? For in all places there will be a great solitude;
27 for one man will desire to see another, or to hear his voice.
28 For of a city there will be ten left, and two of the field, who have hidden themselves in the thick groves, and in the clefts of the rocks.
29 As in an orchard of olives upon every tree there may be left three or four olives,
30 or as when a vineyard is gathered, there are some clusters left by those who diligently search through the vineyard,
31 even so in those days, there will be three or four left by those who search their houses with the sword.
32 The earth will be left desolate, and its fields will be for briers, and its roads and

all her paths will grow thorns, because no sheep will pass along them.
33 The virgins will mourn, having no bridegrooms. The women will mourn, having no husbands. Their daughters will mourn, having no helpers.
34 Their bridegrooms will be destroyed in the wars, and their husbands will perish of famine.
35 Hear now these things, and understand them, you servants of the Lord.
36 Behold, the Lord's word: receive it. Don't doubt the things about which the Lord speaks.
37 Behold, the calamities draw near, and are not delayed.
38 Just as a woman with child in the ninth month, when the hour of her delivery draws near, within two or three hours great pains surround her womb, and when the child comes out from the womb, there will be no waiting for a moment,
39 even so the calamities won't delay coming upon the earth. The world will groan, and sorrows will seize it on every side.
40 "O my people, hear my word: prepare for battle, and in those calamities be like strangers on the earth.
41 He who sells, let him be as he who flees away, and he who buys, as one who will lose.
42 Let he who does business be as he who has no profit by it, and he who builds, as he who won't dwell in it,
43 and he who sows, as if he wouldn't reap, so also he who prunes the vines, as he who won't gather the grapes,
44 those who marry, as those who will have no children, and those who don't marry, as the widowed.
45 Because of this, those who labor, labor in vain;
46 for foreigners will reap their fruits, plunder their goods, overthrow their houses, and take their children captive, for in captivity and famine they will conceive their children.
47 Those who conduct business, do so only to be plundered. The more they adorn their cities, their houses, their possessions, and their own persons,
48 the more I will hate them for their sins," says the Lord.
49 Just as a respectable and virtuous woman hates a prostitute,
50 so will righteousness hate iniquity when she adorns herself, and will accuse her to her face when he comes who will defend him who diligently searches out every sin on earth.
51 Therefore don't be like her or her works.
52 For yet a little while, and iniquity will be taken away out of the earth, and righteousness will reign over us.
53 Don't let the sinner say that he has not sinned; for God will burn coals of fire on the head of one who says "I haven't sinned before God and his glory."
54 Behold, the Lord knows all the works of men, their imaginations, their thoughts, and their hearts.
55 He said, "Let the earth be made," and it was made, "Let the sky be made," and it was made.
56 At his word, the stars were established, and he knows the number of the stars.
57 He searches the deep and its treasures. He has measured the sea and what it contains.
58 He has shut the sea in the midst of the waters, and with his word, he hung the earth over the waters.
59 He has spread out the sky like a vault. He has founded it over the waters.
60 He has made springs of water in the desert and pools on the tops of the mountains to send out rivers from the heights to water the earth.
61 He formed man, and put a heart in the midst of the body, and gave him breath, life, and understanding,
62 yes, the spirit of God Almighty. He who made all things and searches out hidden things in hidden places,
63 surely he knows your imagination, and what you think in your hearts. Woe to those who sin, and try to hide their sin!
64 Because the Lord will exactly investigate all your works, and he will put you all to shame.

65 When your sins are brought out
before men, you will be ashamed, and
your own iniquities will stand as your
accusers in that day.
66 What will you do? Or how will you
hide your sins before God and his angels?
67 Behold, God is the judge. Fear him!
Stop sinning, and forget your iniquities, to
never again commit them. So will God
lead you out, and deliver you from all
suffering.
68 For, behold, the burning wrath of a
great multitude is kindled over you, and
they will take away some of you, and feed
you with that which is sacrificed to idols.
69 Those who consent to them will be
held in derision and in contempt, and be
trodden under foot.
70 For there will be in various places,
and in the next cities, a great insurrection
against those who fear the Lord.
71 They will be like mad men, sparing
none, but spoiling and destroying those
who still fear the Lord.
72 For they will destroy and plunder
their goods, and throw them out of their
houses.
73 Then the trial of my elect will be
made known, even as the gold that is tried
in the fire.
74 Hear, my elect ones, says the Lord:
“Behold, the days of suffering are at hand,
and I will deliver you from them.
75 Don’t be afraid, and don’t doubt, for
God is your guide.
76 You who keep my commandments
and precepts,” says the Lord God, “don’t
let your sins weigh you down, and don’t
let your iniquities lift themselves up.”
77 Woe to those who are choked with
their sins and covered with their
iniquities, like a field is choked with
bushes, and its path covered with thorns,
that no one may travel through!
78 It is shut off and given up to be
consumed by fire.

The Fourth Book of the Maccabees

The Fourth Book of the Maccabees appears in an appendix to the Greek Septuagint. It is considered to be apocrypha by most church traditions. It is preserved here for its supplementary historical value.

1 As I am going to demonstrate a most philosophical proposition, namely, that religious reasoning is absolute master of the emotions. I would willingly advise you to give the utmost heed to philosophy.
2 For reason is necessary to everyone as a step to science. In addition, it embraces the praise of self-control, the highest virtue.
3 If, then, reasoning appears to hold the mastery over the emotions which stand in the way of temperance, such as gluttony and lust,
4 it surely also and manifestly rules over the affections which are contrary to justice, such as malice, and of those which are hindrances to courage, such as wrath, pain, and fear.
5 Perhaps some may ask, “How is it, then, that reasoning, if it rules the emotions, isn’t also master of forgetfulness and ignorance?” They attempt a ridiculous argument.
6 For reasoning does not rule over its own emotions, but over those that are contrary to justice, courage, temperance, and self-control; and yet over these, so as to withstand, without destroying them.
7 I might prove to you from many other considerations, that religious reasoning is sole master of the emotions;
8 but I will prove it with the greatest force from the fortitude of Eleazar, and seven kindred, and their mother, who suffered death in defense of virtue.
9 For all these, treating pains with contempt even to death, by this contempt, demonstrated that reasoning has command over the emotions.
10 For their virtues, then, it is right that I should commend those men who died with their mother at this time on behalf of nobility and goodness; and for their honors, I may count them blessed.
11 For they, winning admiration not only from men in general, but even from the persecutors, for their courage and endurance, became the means of the destruction of the tyranny against their nation, having conquered the tyrant by their endurance, so that by them their country was purified.
12 But we may now at once enter upon the question, having commenced, as is our custom, with laying down the doctrine, and so proceed to the account of these people, giving glory to the all-wise God.
13 Therefore the question is whether reasoning is absolute master of the emotions.
14 Let’s determine, then, what reasoning is and what emotion is, and how many forms of emotion there are, and whether reasoning rules over all of these.
15 Reasoning is intellect accompanied by a life of righteousness, putting foremost the consideration of wisdom.
16 Wisdom is a knowledge of divine and human things, and of their causes.
17 This is contained in the education of the law, by means of which we learn divine things reverently and human things profitably.
18 The forms of wisdom are self-control, justice, courage, and temperance.
19 The leading one of these is self-control, by whose means, indeed, it is that reasoning rules over the emotions.
20 Of the emotions, pleasure and pain are the two most comprehensive; and they also by nature refer to the soul.
21 There are many attendant affections surrounding pleasure and pain.
22 Before pleasure is lust; and after pleasure, joy.
23 Before pain is fear; and after pain is sorrow.
24 Wrath is an affection, common to pleasure and to pain, if any one will pay attention when it comes upon him.
25 There exists in pleasure a malicious disposition, which is the most complex of

all the affections.
26 In the soul, it is arrogance, love of money, thirst for honor, contention, faithlessness, and the evil eye.
27 In the body, it is greediness, indiscriminate eating, and solitary gluttony.
28 As pleasure and pain are, therefore, two growths out of the body and the soul, so there are many offshoots of these emotions.
29 Reasoning, the universal farmer, purging and pruning each of these, tying up, watering, and transplanting, in every way improves the materials of the morals and affections.
30 For reasoning is the leader of the virtues, but it is the sole ruler of the emotions.
Observe then first, through the very things which stand in the way of temperance, that reasoning is absolute ruler of the emotions.
31 Now temperance consists of a command over the lusts.
32 But of the lusts, some belong to the soul and others to the body. Reasoning appears to rule over both.
33 Otherwise, how is it that when urged on to forbidden meats, we reject the gratification which would come from them? Isn't it because reasoning is able to command the appetites? I believe so.
34 Hence it is, then, that when craving seafood, birds, four-footed animals, and all kinds of food which are forbidden to us by the law, we withhold ourselves through the mastery of reasoning.
35 For the affections of our appetites are resisted by the temperate understanding, and bent back again, and all the impulses of the body are reined in by reasoning.

2

1 Is it any wonder? If the lusts of the soul, after participation with what is beautiful, are frustrated,
2 on this ground, therefore, the temperate Joseph is praised in that by reasoning, he subdued, on reflection, the indulgence of the senses.
3 For, although young, and ripe for sexual intercourse, he nullified by reasoning the stimulus of his emotions.
4 It isn't merely the stimulus of sensual indulgence, but that of every desire, that reasoning is able to master.
5 For instance, the law says, "You shall not covet your neighbor's wife, nor anything that belongs to your neighbor."
6 Now, then, since it is the law which has forbidden us to desire, I shall much the more easily persuade you, that reasoning is able to govern our lusts, just as it does the affections which are impediments to justice.
7 Since in what way is a solitary eater, a glutton, and a drunkard reclaimed, unless it is clear that reasoning is lord of the emotions?
8 Therefore, a man who regulates his course by the law, even if he is a lover of money, immediately puts pressure on his own disposition by lending to the needy without interest, and cancelling the debt on the seventh year.
9 If a man is greedy, he is ruled by the law acting through reasoning, so that he doesn't glean his harvest crops or vintage. In reference to other points we may perceive that it is reasoning that conquers his emotions.
10 For the law conquers even affection toward parents, not surrendering virtue on their account.
11 It prevails over love for one's wife, rebuking her when she breaks the law.
12 It lords it over the love of parents toward their children, for they punish them for vice. It domineers over the intimacy of friends, reproving them when wicked.
13 Don't think it is a strange assertion that reasoning can on behalf of the law conquer even enmity.
14 It doesn't allow cutting down the fruit trees of an enemy, but preserves them from the destroyers, and collects their fallen ruins.
15 Reason appears to be master of the more violent emotions, like love of empire, empty boasting, and slander.

16 For the temperate understanding repels all these malignant emotions, as it does wrath; for it masters even this.
17 Thus Moses, when angered against Dathan and Abiram, did nothing to them in wrath, but regulated his anger by reasoning.
18 For the temperate mind is able, as I said, to be superior to the emotions, and to correct some and destroy others.
19 For why else did our most wise father Jacob blame Simeon and Levi for having irrationally slain the whole race of the Shechemites, saying, “Cursed be their anger!”?
20 For if reasoning didn’t possess the power of subduing angry affections, he would not have said this.
21 For at the time when God created man, he implanted within him his emotions and moral nature.
22 At that time he enthroned the mind above all as the holy leader, through the medium of the senses.
23 He gave a law to this mind, by living according to which it will maintain a temperate, just, good, and courageous reign.
24 How, then, a man may say, if reasoning is master of the emotions, has it no control over forgetfulness and ignorance?

3

1 The argument is exceedingly ridiculous, for reasoning doesn’t appear to rule over its own affections, but over those of the body,
2 in such a way as that any one of you may not be able to root out desire, but reasoning will enable you to avoid being enslaved to it.
3 One may not be able to root out anger from the soul, but it is possible to withstand anger.
4 Any one of you may not be able to eradicate malice, but reasoning has force to work with you to prevent you yielding to malice.
5 For reasoning is not an eradicator, but an antagonist of the emotions.
6 This may be more clearly comprehended from the thirst of King David.
7 For after David had been attacking the Philistines the whole day, he with the soldiers of his nation killed many of them;
8 then when evening came, sweating and very weary, he came to the royal tent, around which the entire army of our ancestors was encamped.
9 Now all the rest of them were at supper;
10 but the king, being very much thirsty, although he had numerous springs, could not by their means quench his thirst;
11 but a certain irrational longing for the water in the enemy’s camp grew stronger and fiercer upon him, undid and consumed him.
12 Therefore his bodyguards being troubled at this longing of the king, two valiant young soldiers, respecting the desire of the king, fully armed themselves, and taking a pitcher, got over the ramparts of the enemies.
13 Unperceived by the guardians of the gate, they went throughout the whole camp of the enemy in quest.
14 Having boldly discovered the fountain, they filled out of it the drink for the king.
15 But he, though parched with thirst, reasoned that a drink regarded of equal value to blood would be terribly dangerous to his soul.
16 Therefore, setting up reasoning in opposition to his desire, he poured out the drink to God.
17 For the temperate mind has power to conquer the pressure of the emotions, to quench the fires of excitement,
18 and to wrestle down the pains of the body, however excessive, and through the excellency of reasoning, to spurn all the assaults of the emotions.
19 But the occasion now invites us to give an illustration of temperate reasoning from history.
20 For at a time when our fathers were in possession of undisturbed peace through obedience to the law and were

prosperous, so that Seleucus Nicanor, the king of Asia, both assigned them money for divine service, and accepted their form of government,
21 then certain people, bringing in new things contrary to the public harmony, in various ways fell into calamities.

4

1 For a certain man named Simon, who was in opposition to an honorable and good man who once held the high priesthood for life, named Onias. After slandering Onias in every way, Simon couldn't injure him with the people, so he went away as an exile, with the intention of betraying his country.
2 When coming to Apollonius, the military governor of Syria, Phoenicia, and Cilicia, he said,
3 "Having good will to the king's affairs, I have come to inform you that tens of thousands in private wealth is laid up in the treasuries of Jerusalem which do not belong to the temple, but belong to King Seleucus."
4 Apollonius, acquainting himself with the particulars of this, praised Simon for his care of the king's interests, and going up to Seleucus informed him of the treasure.
5 Getting authority about it, and quickly advancing into our country with the accursed Simon and a very heavy force,
6 he said that he came with the commands of the king that he should take the private money of the treasury.
7 The nation, indignant at this proclamation, and replying to the effect that it was extremely unfair that those who had committed deposits to the sacred treasury should be deprived of them, resisted as well as they could.
8 But Appolonius went away with threats into the temple.
9 The priests, with the women and children, asked God to throw his shield over the holy, despised place,
10 and Appolonius was going up with his armed force to seize the treasure, when angels from heaven appeared riding on horseback, all radiant in armor, filling them with much fear and trembling.
11 Apollonius fell half dead on the court which is open to all nations, and extended his hands to heaven, and implored the Hebrews, with tears, to pray for him, and take away the wrath of the heavenly army.
12 For he said that he had sinned, so as to be consequently worthy of death, and that if he were saved, he would proclaim to all people the blessedness of the holy place.
13 Onias the high priest, induced by these words, although for other reasons anxious that King Seleucus wouldn't suppose that Apollonius was slain by human device and not by Divine punishment, prayed for him;
14 and he being thus unexpectedly saved, departed to report to the king what had happened to him.
15 But on the death of Seleucus the king, his son Antiochus Epiphanes succeeded to the kingdom—a terrible man of arrogant pride.

16 He, having deposed Onias from the high priesthood, appointed his brother Jason to be high priest,
17 who had made a covenant, if he would give him this authority, to pay yearly three thousand six hundred and sixty talents.
18 He committed to him the high priesthood and rulership over the nation.
19 He both changed the manner of living of the people, and perverted their civil customs into all lawlessness.
20 So that he not only erected a gymnasium on the very citadel of our country, but neglected the guardianship of the temple.
21 Because of that, Divine vengeance was grieved and instigated Antiochus himself against them.
22 For being at war with Ptolemy in Egypt, he heard that on a report of his death being spread abroad, the inhabitants of Jerusalem had exceedingly rejoiced, and he quickly marched against them.

23 Having subdued them, he established
a decree that if any of them lived
according to the ancestral laws, he should
die.
24 When he could by no means destroy
by his decrees the obedience to the law of
the nation, but saw all his threats and
punishments without effect,
25 for even women, because they
continued to circumcise their children,
were flung down a precipice along with
them, knowing beforehand of the
punishment.
26 When, therefore, his decrees were
disregarded by the people, he himself
compelled by means of tortures every one
of this race, by tasting forbidden meats, to
renounce the Jewish religion.

5

1 The tyrant Antiochus, therefore,
sitting in public state with his assessors
upon a certain lofty place, with his armed
troops standing in a circle around him,
2 commanded his spearbearers to seize
every one of the Hebrews, and to compel
them to taste swine's flesh and things
offered to idols.
3 Should any of them be unwilling to eat
the accursed food, they were to be
tortured on the wheel and so killed.
4 When many had been seized, a
foremost man of the assembly, a Hebrew,
by name Eleazar, a priest by family, by
profession a lawyer, and advanced in
years, and for this reason known to many
of the king's followers, was brought near
to him.
5 Antiochus, seeing him, said,
6 "I would counsel you, old man, before
your tortures begin, to taste the swine's
flesh, and save your life; for I feel respect
for your age and hoary head, which since
you have had so long, you appear to me to
be no philosopher in retaining the
superstition of the Jews.
7 For therefore, since nature has
conferred upon you the most excellent
flesh of this animal, do you loathe it?
8 It seems senseless not to enjoy what is
pleasant, yet not disgraceful; and from
notions of sinfulness, to reject the gifts of
nature.
9 You will be acting, I think, still more
senselessly, if you follow vain conceits
about the truth.
10 You will, moreover, be despising me
to your own punishment.
11 Won't you awake from your trifling
philosophy, give up the folly of your
notions, and regaining understanding
worthy of your age, search into the truth
of an expedient course?
12 Won't you respect my kindly
admonition and have pity on your own
years?
13 For bear in mind that if there is any
power which watches over this religion of
yours, it will pardon you for all
transgressions of the law which you
commit through compulsion."
14 While the tyrant incited him in this
manner to the unlawful eating of meat,
Eleazar begged permission to speak.
15 Having received permission to speak,
he began to address the people as follows:
16 "We, O Antiochus, who are persuaded
that we live under a divine law, consider
no compulsion to be so forcible as
obedience to that law.
17 Therefore we consider that we ought
not to transgress the law in any way.
18 Indeed, were our law (as you
suppose) not truly divine, and if we
wrongly think it divine, we would have no
right even in that case to destroy our
sense of religion.
19 Don't think that eating unclean meat
is a trifling offense.
20 For transgression of the law, whether
in small or great matters, is of equal
importance;
21 for in either case the law is equally
slighted.
22 But you deride our philosophy, as
though we lived in it irrationally.
23 Yet it instructs us in self-control, so
that we are superior to all pleasures and
lusts; and it trains us in courage, so that
we cheerfully undergo every grievance.
24 It instructs us in justice, so that in all
our dealings we give what is due. It

teaches us piety, so that we properly worship the one and only God.
25 That is why we don't eat the unclean; for believing that the law was established by God, we are convinced that the Creator of the world, in giving his laws, sympathizes with our nature.
26 Those things which are suitable for our souls, he has directed us to eat; but those which are not, he has forbidden.
27 But, tyrant-like, you not only force us to break the law, but also to eat, that you may ridicule us as we thus profanely eat.
28 But you won't have this cause of laughter against me,
29 nor will I transgress the sacred oaths of my forefathers to keep the law.
30 No, not if you pluck out my eyes, and consume my entrails.
31 I am not so old, and void of courage as to not be youthful in reason and in defense of my religion.
32 Now then, prepare your wheels, and kindle a fiercer flame.
33 I will not so pity my old age, as on my account to break the law of my country.
34 I will not play false to you, O law, my instructor, or forsake you, O beloved self-control!
35 I will not put you to shame, O philosopher Reason, or deny you, O honored priesthood and knowledge of the law.
36 Mouth! You shall not pollute my old age, nor the full stature of a perfect life.
37 My ancestors will receive me as pure, not having feared your compulsion, even to death.
38 For you will rule like a tyrant over the ungodly, but you will not lord it over my thoughts about religion, either by your arguments, or through deeds."

6

1 When Eleazar had in this manner answered the exhortations of the tyrant, the spearbearers came up, and rudely dragged Eleazar to the instruments of torture.
2 First, they stripped the old man, adorned as he was with the beauty of piety.
3 Then tying back his arms and hands, they disdainfully flogged him.
4 A herald opposite cried out, "Obey the commands of the king!"
5 But the high-minded and truly noble Eleazar, as one tortured in a dream, ignored it.
6 But raising his eyes on high to heaven, the old man's flesh was stripped off by the scourges, and his blood streamed down, and his sides were pierced through.
7 Falling on the ground from his body having no power to endure the pains, he still kept his reasoning upright and unbending.
8 Then one of the harsh spearbearers rushed at him and began to kick him in the side to force him to get up again after he fell.
9 But he endured the pains, despised the cruelty, and persevered through the indignities.
10 Like a noble athlete, the old man, when struck, vanquished his torturers.
11 His face sweating, and he panting for breath, he was admired even by the torturers for his courage.
12 Therefore, partly in pity for his old age,
13 partly from the sympathy of acquaintance, and partly in admiration of his endurance, some of the attendants of the king said,
14 "Why do you unreasonably destroy yourself, O Eleazar, with these miseries?
15 We will bring you some meat cooked by yourself, and you can save yourself by pretending that you have eaten swine's flesh."
16 Eleazar, as though the advice more painfully tortured him, cried out,
17 "Let us who are children of Abraham not be so evil advised as by giving way to make use of an unbecoming pretense.
18 For it would be irrational, if having lived up to old age in all truth, and having scrupulously guarded our character for it, we would now turn back
19 and ourselves become a pattern of impiety to the young, as being an example of eating pollution.

20 It would be disgraceful if we would
live on some short time, and that scorned
by all men for cowardice,
21 and be condemned by the tyrant for
cowardice by not contending to the death
for our divine law.
22 Therefore you, O children of
Abraham, die nobly for your religion.
23 You spearbearers of the tyrant, why
do you linger?"
24 Beholding him so high-minded
against misery, and not changing at their
pity, they led him to the fire.
25 Then with their wickedly contrived
instruments they burned him on the fire,
and poured stinking fluids down into his
nostrils.
26 He being at length burned down to
the bones, and about to expire, raised his
eyes Godward, and said,
27 "You know, O God, that when I might
have been saved, I am slain for the sake of
the law by tortures of fire.
28 Be merciful to your people, and be
satisfied with the punishment of me on
their account.
29 Let my blood be a purification for
them, and take my life in exchange for
theirs."
30 Thus speaking, the holy man
departed, noble in his torments, and even
to the agonies of death resisted in his
reasoning for the sake of the law.
31 Confessedly, therefore, religious
reasoning is master of the emotions.
32 For had the emotions been superior
to reasoning, I would have given them the
witness of this mastery.
33 But now, since reasoning conquered
the emotions, we befittingly award it the
authority of first place.
34 It is only fair that we should allow
that the power belongs to reasoning, since
it masters external miseries.
35 It would be ridiculous if it weren't so.
I prove that reasoning has not only
mastered pains, but that it is also superior
to the pleasures, and withstands them.

7

1 The reasoning of our father Eleazar,
like a first-rate pilot, steering the vessel of
piety in the sea of emotions,
2 and flouted by the threats of the
tyrant, and overwhelmed with the
breakers of torture,
3 in no way shifted the rudder of piety
until it sailed into the harbor of victory
over death.
4 No besieged city has ever held out
against many and various war machines
as that holy man did when his pious soul
was tried with the fiery trial of tortures
and rackings and moved his besiegers
through the religious reasoning that
shielded him.
5 For father Eleazar, projecting his
disposition, broke the raging waves of the
emotions as with a jutting cliff.
6 O priest worthy of the priesthood! You
didn't pollute your sacred teeth, nor make
your appetite, which had always
embraced the clean and lawful, a
partaker of profanity.
7 O harmonizer with the law, and sage
devoted to a divine life!
8 Of such a character ought those to be
who perform the duties of the law at the
risk of their own blood, and defend it with
generous sweat by sufferings even to
death.
9 You, father, have gloriously
established our right government by your
endurance; and making of much account
our past service, prevented its
destruction, and by your deeds, have
made credible the words of philosophy.
10 O aged man of more power than
tortures, elder more vigorous than fire,
greatest king over the emotions, Eleazar!
11 For as father Aaron, armed with a
censer, hastening through the consuming
fire, vanquished the flame-bearing angel,
12 so, Eleazar, the descendant of Aaron,
wasted away by the fire, didn't give up his
reasoning.
13 What is most wonderful is that
though he was an old man, though the
labors of his body were now spent, his
muscles were relaxed, and his sinews
worn out, he recovered youth.
14 By the spirit of reasoning, and the

reasoning of Isaac, he rendered powerless the many-headed rack.
15 O blessed old age, and reverend hoar head, and life obedient to the law, which the faithful seal of death perfected.
16 If, then, an old man, through religion, despised tortures even to death, then certainly religious reasoning is ruler of the emotions.
17 But perhaps some might say, “It is not all who conquer emotions, as not all possess wise reasoning.”
18 But those who have meditated upon religion with their whole heart, these alone can master the emotions of the flesh:
19 they who believe that to God they don’t die; for, as our forefathers, Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, they live to God.
20 This circumstance, then, is by no means an objection, that some who have weak reasoning are governed by their emotions,
21 since what person, walking religiously by the whole rule of philosophy, and believing in God,
22 and knowing that it is a blessed thing to endure all kinds of hardships for virtue, would not, for the sake of religion, master his emotion?
23 For only the wise and brave man is lord over his emotions.
24 This is why even boys, trained with the philosophy of religious reasoning, have conquered still more bitter tortures;
25 for when the tyrant was manifestly vanquished in his first attempt, in being unable to force the old man to eat the unclean thing,

8

1 then, indeed, vehemently swayed with emotion, he commanded to bring others of the adult Hebrews, and if they would eat of the unclean thing, to let them go when they had eaten; but if they objected, to torment them more grievously.
2 The tyrant having given this charge, seven kindred were brought into his presence, along with their aged mother. They were handsome, modest, well-born, and altogether comely.
3 When the tyrant saw them encircling their mother as in a dance, he was pleased with them. Being struck with their becoming and innocent manner, smiled at them, and calling them near, said,
4 “O youths, with favorable feelings, I admire the beauty of each of you. Greatly honouring so numerous a band of kindred, I not only counsel you not to share the madness of the old man who has been tortured before,
5 but I beg you to yield, and to enjoy my friendship; for I possess the power, not only of punishing those who disobey my commands, but of doing good to those who obey them.
6 Put confidence in me, then, and you will receive places of authority in my government, if you forsake your national way of life,
7 and, conforming to the Greek way of life, alter your rule and revel in youth’s delights.
8 For if you provoke me by your disobedience, you will compel me to destroy every one of you with terrible punishments by tortures.
9 Have mercy, then, upon your own selves, whom I, although an enemy, am compassionate for your age and attractive appearance.
10 Won’t you consider this: that if you disobey, there will be nothing left for you but to die in torture?”
11 When he had said this, he ordered the instruments of torture to be brought forward, that fear might prevail upon them to eat unclean meat.
12 When the spearman brought forward the wheels, the racks, the hooks, caldrons, pans, finger-racks, iron hands and wedges, and bellows, the tyrant continued:
13 “Fear, young men, and the righteousness which you worship will be merciful to you if you transgress because of compulsion.”
14 Now they having listened to these words of persuasion, and seeing the

fearful instruments, not only were not afraid, but even answered the arguments of the tyrant, and through their good reasoning destroyed his power.

15 Now let's consider the matter. Had any of them been weak-spirited and cowardly among them, what reasoning would they have employed but these?

16 "O wretched that we are, and exceedingly senseless! When the king exhorts us, and calls us to his bounty, should we not obey him?

17 Why do we cheer ourselves with vain counsels, and venture upon a disobedience bringing death?

18 Shall we not fear, O kindred, the instruments of torture and weigh the threatenings of torment and shun this vain-glory and destructive pride?

19 Let's have compassion upon our age and relent over the years of our mother.

20 Let's bear in mind that we will be dying as rebels.

21 Divine Justice will pardon us if we fear the king through necessity.

22 Why withdraw ourselves from a most sweet life, and deprive ourselves of this pleasant world?

23 Let's not oppose necessity, nor seek vain-glory by our own torture.

24 The law itself wouldn't arbitrarily put us to death because we dread torture.

25 Why has such angry zeal taken root in us, and such fatal obstinacy approved itself to us, when we might live unmolested by the king?"

26 But the young men didn't say or think anything of this kind when about to be tortured.

27 For they were well aware of the sufferings, and masters of the pains.

28-29 So that as soon as the tyrant had ceased counselling them to eat the unclean, they all with one voice, as from the same heart said:

9

1 "Why do you delay, O tyrant? For we are more ready to die than to transgress the injunctions of our fathers.

2 We would be disgracing our fathers if we didn't obey the law, and take knowledge for our guide.

3 O tyrant, counselor of law-breaking, do not, hating us as you do, pity us more than we pity ourselves.

4 For we consider your escape to be worse than death.

5 You try to scare us by threatening us with death by tortures, as though you had learned nothing by the death of Eleazar.

6 But if aged men of the Hebrews have died in the cause of religion after enduring torture, more rightly should we younger men die, scorning your cruel tortures, which our aged instructor overcame.

7 Make the attempt, then, O tyrant. If you put us to death for our religion, don't think that you harm us by torturing us.

8 For we through this ill-treatment and endurance will gain the rewards of virtue.

9 But you, for the wicked and despotic slaughter of us, will, from the Divine vengeance, endure eternal torture by fire."

10 When they had said this, the tyrant was not only exasperated against them for being disobedient, but enraged with them for being ungrateful.

11 So, at his bidding, the torturers brought the oldest of them, and tearing through his tunic, bound his hands and arms on each side with straps.

12 When they had labored hard without effect in scourging him, they hurled him on the wheel.

13 The noble youth, extended upon this, became dislocated.

14 With every member disjointed, he denounced the tyrant, saying,

15 "O most accursed tyrant, and enemy of heavenly justice, and cruel-hearted, I am no murderer, nor sacrilegious man, whom you torture, but a defender of the Divine law."

16 And when the spearmen said, "Consent to eat, that you may be released from your tortures,"

17 he answered, "Not so powerful, O accursed lackeys, is your wheel, as to

stifle my reasoning. Cut my limbs, and burn my flesh, and twist my joints.
18 For through all my torments I will convince you that the children of the Hebrews are alone unconquered on behalf of virtue."
19 While he was saying this, they heaped up fuel, and setting fire to it, strained him on the wheel still more.
20 The wheel was defiled all over with blood. The hot ashes were quenched by the droppings of gore, and pieces of flesh were scattered about the axles of the machine.
21 Although the framework of his bones was now destroyed, the high-minded and Abrahamic youth didn't groan.
22 But, as though transformed by fire into immortality, he nobly endured the rackings, saying,
23 "Imitate me, O kindred. Never desert your station, nor renounce my brotherhood in courage. Fight the holy and honorable fight of religion,
24 by which means our just and paternal Providence, becoming merciful to the nation, will punish the pestilent tyrant."
25 Saying this, the revered youth abruptly closed his life.

26 When all admired his courageous soul, the spearmen brought forward him who was second oldest, and having put on iron gauntlets with sharp hooks, bound him to the rack.
27 When, on enquiring whether he would eat before he was tortured, they heard his noble sentiment.
28 After they with the iron gauntlets had violently dragged all the flesh from the neck to the chin, the panther-like animals tore off the very skin of his head, but he, bearing with firmness this misery, said,
29 "How sweet is every form of death for the religion of our fathers!" Then he said to the tyrant,
30 "Don't you think, most cruel of all tyrants, that you are now tortured more than I, finding your arrogant conception of tyranny conquered by our perseverance in behalf of our religion?
31 For I lighten my suffering by the pleasures which are connected with virtue.
32 But you are tortured with threatenings for impiety. You won't escape, most corrupt tyrant, the vengeance of Divine wrath."

10

1 Now this one endured this praiseworthy death. The third was brought along, and exhorted by many to taste and save his life.
2 But he cried out and said, "Don't you know that the father of those who are dead is my father also, and that the same mother bore me, and that I was brought up in the same way?
3 I don't renounce the noble relationship of my kindred.
4 Now then, whatever instrument of vengeance you have, apply it to my body, for you aren't able to touch my soul, even if you want to."
5 But they, highly incensed at his boldness of speech, dislocated his hands and feet with racking engines, and wrenching them from their sockets, dismembered him.
6 They dragged around his fingers, his arms, his legs, and his ankles.
7 Not being able by any means to strangle him, they tore off his skin, together with the extreme tips of his fingers, and then dragged him to the wheel,
8 around which his vertebral joints were loosened, and he saw his own flesh torn to shreds, and streams of blood flowing from his entrails.
9 When about to die, he said,
10 "We, O accursed tyrant, suffer this for the sake of Divine education and virtue.
11 But you, for your impiety and blood shedding, will endure unceasing torments."
12 Thus having died worthily of his kindred, they dragged forward the fourth, saying,
13 "Don't share the madness of your kindred, but respect the king and save yourself."

14 But he said to them, “You don’t have a
fire so scorching as to make me play the
coward.
15 By the blessed death of my kindred,
and the eternal punishment of the tyrant,
and the glorious life of the pious, I will not
repudiate the noble brotherhood.
16 Invent, O tyrant, tortures, that you
may learn, even through them, that I am
the brother of those tormented before.”
17 When he had said this, the
blood-thirsty, murderous, and unholy
Antiochus ordered his tongue to be cut
out.
18 But he said, “Even if you take away
the organ of speech, God still hears the
silent.
19 Behold, my tongue is extended, cut it
off; for in spite of that you won’t silence
our reasoning.
20 We gladly lose our limbs on behalf of
God.
21 But God will speedily find you, since
you cut off the tongue, the instrument of
divine melody.”

11

1 When he had died, disfigured in his
torments, the fifth leaped forward, and
said,
2 “I don’t intend, O tyrant, to get excused
from the torment which is on behalf of
virtue.
3 But I have come of my own accord,
that by my death you may owe heavenly
vengeance and punishment for more
crimes.
4 O you hater of virtue and of men, what
have we done that you thus revel in our
blood?
5 Does it seem evil to you that we
worship the Founder of all things, and live
according to his surpassing law?
6 But this is worthy of honors, not
torments,
7 if you had been capable of the higher
feelings of men, and possessed the hope of
salvation from God.
8 Behold now, being alien from God, you
make war against those who are religious
toward God.”
9 As he said this, the spearbearers
bound him and drew him to the rack,
10 to which binding him at his knees,
and fastening them with iron fetters, they
bent down his loins upon the wedge of the
wheel; and his body was then
dismembered, scorpion-fashion.
11 With his breath thus confined, and
his body strangled, he said,
12 “A great favor you bestow upon us, O
tyrant, by enabling us to manifest our
adherence to the law by means of nobler
sufferings.”
13 He also being dead, the sixth, quite a
youth, was brought out. On the tyrant
asking him whether he would eat and be
delivered, he said,
14 “I am indeed younger than my
brothers, but in understanding I am as
old.
15 I was born and reared to the same
end. We are bound to die also on behalf of
the same cause.
16 So if you think it is proper to torment
us for not eating the unclean, then
torment!”
17 As he said this, they brought him to
the wheel.
18 Extended upon this, with limbs
racked and dislocated, he was gradually
roasted from beneath.
19 Having heated sharp spits, they
approached them to his back; and having
transfixed his sides, they burned away his
entrails.
20 He, while tormented, said, “O good
and holy contest, in which for the sake of
religion, we kindred have been called to
the arena of pain, and have not been
conquered.
21 For religious understanding, O tyrant,
is unconquered.
22 Armed with upright virtue, I also will
depart with my kindred.
23 I, too, bearing with me a great
avenger, O inventor of tortures, and
enemy of the truly pious.
24 We six youths have destroyed your
tyranny.
25 For isn’t your inability to overrule our
reasoning, and to compel us to eat the
unclean, your destruction?
26 Your fire is cold to us. Your racks are
painless, and your violence harmless.

27 For the guards not of a tyrant but of a divine law are our defenders. Through this we keep our reasoning unconquered."

12

1 When he, too, had undergone blessed martyrdom, and died in the cauldron into which he had been thrown, the seventh, the youngest of all, came forward,
2 whom the tyrant pitying, though he had been dreadfully reproached by his kindred,
3 seeing him already encompassed with chains, had him brought nearer, and endeavored to counsel him, saying,
4 "You see the end of the madness of your kindred, for they have died in torture through disobedience. You, if disobedient, having been miserably tormented, will yourself perish prematurely.
5 But if you obey, you will be my friend, and have a charge over the affairs of the kingdom."
6 Having thus exhorted him, he sent for the boy's mother, that, by showing compassion to her for the loss of so many sons, he might incline her, through the hope of safety, to make the survivor obedient.
7 He, after his mother had urged him on in the Hebrew tongue, (as we will soon relate) said,
8 "Release me that I may speak to the king and all his friends."
9 They, rejoicing exceedingly at the promise of the youth, quickly let him go.
10 He, running up to the pans, said,
11 "Impious tyrant, and most blasphemous man, were you not ashamed, having received prosperity and a kingdom from God, to kill His servants, and to rack the doers of godliness?
12 Therefore the divine vengeance is reserving you for eternal fire and torments, which will cling to you for all time.
13 Weren't you ashamed, man as you are, yet most savage, to cut out the tongues of men of like feeling and origin, and having thus abused to torture them?
14 But they, bravely dying, fulfilled their religion toward God.
15 But you will groan as you deserve for having slain without cause the champions of virtue.
16 Therefore," he continued, "I myself, being about to die,
17 will not forsake my kindred.
18 I call upon the God of my fathers to be merciful to my race.
19 But you, both living and dead, he will punish."
20 Thus having prayed, he hurled himself into the pans; and so expired.

13

1 If then, the seven kindred despised troubles even to death, it is admitted on all sides that righteous reasoning is absolute master over the emotions.
2 For just as if they had eaten of the unholy as slaves to the emotions, we would have said that they had been conquered by them.
3 Now it is not so. But by means of the reasoning which is praised by God, they mastered their emotions.
4 It is impossible to overlook the leadership of reflection, for it gained the victory over both emotions and troubles.
5 How, then, can we avoid according to these men mastery of emotion through right reasoning, since they didn't withdraw from the pains of fire?
6 For just as by means of towers projecting in front of harbors men break the threatening waves, and thus assure a still course to vessels entering port,
7 so that seven-towered right-reasoning of the young men, securing the harbour of religion, conquered the tempest of emotions.
8 For having arranged a holy choir of piety, they encouraged one another, saying,
9 "Brothers, may we die brotherly for the law. Let us imitate the three young men in Assyria who despised the equally afflicting furnace.

10 Let's not be cowards in the
manifestation of piety."
11 One said, "Courage, brother!" and
another, "Nobly endure!"
12 Another said, "Remember of what
stock you are;" and by the hand of our
father Isaac endured to be slain for the
sake of piety.
13 One and all, looking at each other
serene and confident, said, "Let's sacrifice
with all our heart our souls to God who
gave them, and employ our bodies for the
keeping of the law.
14 Let's not fear him who thinks he kills;
15 for great is the trial of soul and danger
of eternal torment laid up for those who
transgress the commandment of God.
16 Let's arm ourselves, therefore, in the
self-control, which is divine reasoning.
17 If we suffer like this, Abraham, Isaac,
and Jacob will receive us, and all the
fathers will commend us.
18 As each one of the kindred was
hauled away, the rest exclaimed, "Don't
disgrace us, O brother, nor falsify those
who died before you!"

19 Now you are not ignorant of the
charm of brotherhood, which the Divine
and all wise Providence has imparted
through fathers to children, and has
engendered through the mother's womb.
20 These brothers remained an equal
time in their mother's womb, and were
formed for the same period, and
nourished by the same blood, and were
perfected through the same principle of
life.
21 They were brought forth at equal
intervals, and sucked milk from the same
fountains. Their brotherly souls were
reared up lovingly together,
22 and increase the more powerfully by
reason of this simultaneous rearing, and
by daily companionship, and by other
education, and exercise in the law of God.

23 Brotherly love being thus
sympathetically constituted, the seven
kindred had a more sympathetic mutual
harmony.
24 For being educated in the same law,
and practicing the same virtues, and
reared up in a just course of life, they
increased this harmony with each other.
25 For the same ardor for what is right
and honorable increased their goodwill
and harmony toward each other.
26 For it acting along with religion, made
their brotherly feeling more desirable to
them.
27 And yet, although nature,
companionship, and virtuous morals
increased their brotherly love, those who
were left endured to see their kindred,
who were mistreated for their religion,
tortured even to death.

14

1 More that this, they even urged them
on to this mistreatment; so that they not
only despised pains themselves, but they
even got the better of their affections of
brotherly love.
2 Reasoning is more royal than a king,
and freer than freemen!
3 What a sacred and harmonious
concert of the seven kindred as
concerning piety!
4 None of the seven youths turned
cowardly or shrank back from death.
5 But all of them, as though running the
road to immortality, hastened on to death
through tortures.
6 For just as hands and feet are moved
sympathetically with the directions of the
soul, so those holy youths agreed to death
for religion's sake, as through the
immortal soul of religion.
7 O holy seven of harmonious kindred!
For as the seven days of creation, about
religion,
8 so the youths, circling around the
number seven, annulled the fear of
torments.
9 We now shudder at the recital of the
affliction of those young men; but they
not only saw, and not only heard the
immediate execution of the threat, but
undergoing it, persevered; and that
through the pains of fire.
10 What could be more painful? For the
power of fire, being sharp and quick,
speedily dissolved their bodies.

11 Don't think it wonderful that reasoning ruled over those men in their torments, when even a woman's mind despised more manifold pains.
12 For the mother of those seven youths endured the rackings of each of her children.
13 Consider how comprehensive is the love of offspring, which draws every one to sympathy of affection,
14 where irrational animals possess a similar sympathy and love for their offspring with men.
15 The tame birds frequenting the roofs of our houses defend their fledglings.
16 Others build their nests and hatch their young on the tops of mountains, in the precipices of valleys, and the holes and tops of trees, and keep intruders away.
17 If not able to do this, they fly circling round them in agony of affection, calling out in their own note, and save their offspring in whatever manner they are able.
18 But why should we point attention to the sympathy toward children shown by irrational animals?
19 Even bees, at the season of honey-making, attack all who approach, and pierce with their sting, as with a sword, those who draw near their hive, and repel them even to death.
20 But sympathy with her children didn't turn away the mother of the young men, who had a spirit kindred with that of Abraham.

15

1 O reasoning of the sons, lord over the emotions, and religion more desirable to a mother than children!
2 The mother, when two things were set before her, religion and the safety of her seven sons for a time, on the conditional promise of a tyrant,
3 rather elected the religion which according to God preserves to eternal life.
4 In what way can I describe ethically the affections of parents toward their children, the resemblance of soul and of form impressed into the small type of a child in a wonderful manner, especially through the greater sympathy of mothers with the feelings of those born of them!
5 For by how much mothers are by nature weak in disposition and prolific in offspring, by so much the fonder they are of children.
6 Of all mothers, the mother of the seven was the fondest of children, who in seven childbirths had deeply engendered love toward them.
7 Through her many pains undergone in connection with each one, she was compelled to feel sympathy with them;
8 yet, through fear of God, she neglected the temporary salvation of her children.
9 Not only so, but on account of the excellent disposition to the law, her maternal affection toward them was increased.
10 For they were both just and temperate, and courageous, high-minded, fond of their kindred, and so fond of their mother that even to death they obeyed her by observing the law.

11 Yet, though there were so many circumstances connected with love of children to draw on a mother to sympathy, in the case of none of them were the various tortures able to pervert her principle.
12 But she inclined each one separately and all together to death for religion.
13 O holy nature and parental feeling, and reward of bringing up children, and unconquerable maternal affection!
14 At the racking and roasting of each one of them, the observant mother was prevented by religion from changing.
15 She saw her children's flesh dissolving around the fire, and their extremities quivering on the ground, and the flesh of their heads dropped forward down to their beards, like masks.

16 O you mother, who was tried at this time with bitterer pangs than those at birth!
17 O you only woman who have produced perfect holiness!
18 Your firstborn, expiring, didn't turn you, nor the second, looking miserable in

his torments, nor the third, breathing out his soul.
19 You didn't weep when you saw each of their eyes looking sternly at their tortures, and their nostrils foreboding death!
20 When you saw children's flesh heaped upon children's flesh that had been torn off, heads decapitated upon heads, dead falling upon the dead, and a choir of children turned through torture into a burying ground, you didn't lament.
21 Not so do siren melodies or songs of swans attract the hearers to listening, O voices of children calling on your mother in the midst of torments!
22 With what and what manner of torments was the mother herself tortured, as her sons were undergoing the wheel and the fires!
23 But religious reasoning, having strengthened her courage in the midst of sufferings, enabled her to forego, for the time, parental love.
24 Although seeing the destruction of seven children, the noble mother, after one embrace, stripped off her feelings through faith in God.
25 For just as in a council room, seeing in her own soul vehement counselors, nature and parentage and love of her children, and the racking of her children,
26 she holding two votes, one for the death, the other for the preservation of her children,
27 didn't lean to that which would have saved her children for the safety of a brief space.
28 But this daughter of Abraham remembered his holy fortitude.
29 O holy mother of a nation, avenger of the law, defender of religion, and prime bearer in the battle of the affections!
30 O you nobler in endurance than males, and more courageous than men in perseverance!
31 For like Noah's ship, bearing the world in the world-filling flood, bore up against the waves,
32 so you, the guardian of the law, when surrounded on every side by the flood of emotions, and assaulted by violent storms which were the torments of your children, bore up nobly against the storms against religion.

16

1 If, then, even a woman, and that an aged one, and the mother of seven children, endured to see her children's torments even to death, it must be admitted that religious reasoning is master even of the emotions.
2 I have proved, then, that not only men have obtained the mastery of their emotions, but also that a woman despised the greatest torments.
3 The lions around Daniel were not so fierce, nor the furnace of Misael burning with most vehement fires as that natural love of children burned within her, when she saw her seven sons tortured.
4 But with the reasoning of religion the mother quenched emotions so great and powerful.
5 For we must consider also this: that, had the woman been faint hearted, as being their mother, she would have lamented over them, and perhaps might have spoken thus:
6 "Ah! I am wretched and many times miserable, who having born seven sons, have become the mother of none.
7 O seven useless childbirths, and seven profitless periods of labor, and fruitless givings of suck, and miserable nursings at the breast.
8 Vainly, for your sakes, O sons, have I endured many pangs, and the more difficult anxieties of rearing.
9 Alas, of my children, some of you unmarried, and some who have married to no profit, I will not see your children, nor have the joy of being a grandmother.
10 Ah, that I who had many and fair children, should be a lone widow full of sorrows!
11 Nor, should I die, will I have a son to bury me." But with such a lament as this, the holy and God-fearing mother wept for none of them.
12 Nor did she divert any of them from death, nor grieve for them as for the dead.
13 But as one possessed with an adamant mind, and as one bringing forth

again her full number of sons to immortality, she rather urged them to death on behalf of religion.
14 O woman, soldier of God for religion, you, aged and a female, have conquered through endurance even a tyrant; and even though weak, have been found more powerful in deeds and words.
15 For when you were seized along with your children, you stood looking at Eleazar in torture, and said to your sons in the Hebrew tongue,
16 "O sons, the contest is noble, to which you being called as a witness for the nation, strive zealously for the laws of your country.
17 For it would be disgraceful if this old man endured pains for the sake of righteousness, and that you who are younger would be afraid of the tortures.
18 Remember that through God, you obtained existence and have enjoyed it.
19 Therefore, you ought to bear every affliction because of God.
20 For him also our father Abraham was zealous to sacrifice Isaac our progenitor, and didn't shudder at the sight of his own paternal hand descending down with the sword upon him.
21 The righteous Daniel was cast to the lions; and Ananias, Azarias, and Misael were hurled into a fiery furnace, yet they endured through God.
22 You, then, having the same faith toward God, don't be troubled.
23 For it is unreasonable that they who know religion wouldn't stand up against troubles.
24 With these arguments, the mother of seven, exhorting each of her sons, encouraged and persuaded them not to transgress God's commandment.
25 They saw this, too, that those who die for God, live to God, like Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, and all the patriarchs.

17

1 Some of the spearbearers said that when she herself was about to be seized for the purpose of being put to death, she threw herself on the pile, rather than let them touch her body.
2 O you mother, who together with seven children destroyed the violence of the tyrant, and rendered void his wicked intentions, and exhibited the nobleness of faith!
3 For you, like a house bravely built on the pillar of your children, bore the shock of tortures without swaying.
4 Cheer up, therefore, O holy-minded mother! Hold the firm hope of your steadfastness with God.
5 Not so gracious does the moon appear with the stars in heaven, as you are established as honorable before God, and fixed in the sky with your sons whom you illuminated with religion to the stars.
6 For your bearing of children was after the manner of a child of Abraham.
7 If it were lawful for us to paint as on a tablet the religion of your story, the spectators wouldn't shudder at seeing the mother of seven children enduring for the sake of religion various tortures even to death.
8 It would have been a worthwhile thing to have inscribed on the tomb itself these words as a memorial to those of the nation,
9 "Here an aged priest, an aged woman, and seven sons, are buried through the violence of a tyrant, who wished to destroy the society of the Hebrews.
10 These also avenged their nation, looking to God, and enduring torments to death."
11 For it was truly a divine contest which was carried through by them.
12 For at that time virtue presided over the contest, approving the victory through endurance, namely, immortality, eternal life.
13 Eleazar was the first to contend. The mother of the seven children entered the contest, and the kindred contended.
14 The tyrant was the antagonist; and the world and living men were the spectators.
15 Reverence for God conquered, and crowned her own athletes.

16 Who didn't admire those champions of true legislation? Who were not amazed?
17 The tyrant himself, and all their council, admired their endurance,
18 through which, they also now stand beside the divine throne and live a blessed life.
19 For Moses says, "All the saints are under your hands."
20 These, therefore, having been sanctified through God, have been honored not only with this honor, but that also by the fact that because of them, the enemy didn't overcome our nation.
21 That tyrant was punished and their country purified.
22 For they became the ransom to the sin of the nation. The Divine Providence saved Israel, which was afflicted before, by the blood of those pious ones and the death that appeased wrath.
23 For the tyrant Antiochus, looking to their courageous virtue and to their endurance in torture, proclaimed that endurance as an example to his soldiers.
24 They proved to be to him noble and brave for land battles and for sieges; and he conquered and stormed the towns of all his enemies.

18

1 O Israelite children, descendants of the seed of Abraham, obey this law and in every way be religious,
2 knowing that religious reasoning is lord of the emotions, and those not only inward but outward.
3 Therefore those people who gave up their bodies to pains for the sake of religion were not only admired by men, but were deemed worthy of a divine portion.
4 The nation through them obtained peace, and having renewed the observance of the law in their country, drove the enemy out of the land.
5 The tyrant Antiochus was both punished on earth, and is punished now that he is dead; for when he was quite unable to compel the Israelites to adopt foreign customs, and to desert the manner of life of their fathers,
6 then, departing from Jerusalem, he made war against the Persians.
7 The righteous mother of the seven children spoke also as follows to her offspring: "I was a pure virgin, and didn't go beyond my father's house, but I took care of the rib from which woman was made.
8 No destroyer of the desert or ravisher of the plain injured me, nor did the destructive, deceitful snake make plunder of my chaste virginity. I remained with my husband during the time of my maturity.
9 When these, my children, arrived at maturity, their father died. He was blessed! For having sought out a life of fertility in children, he was not grieved with a period of loss of children.
10 He used to teach you, when yet with you, the law and the prophets.
11 He used to read to you about the slaying of Abel by Cain, the offering up of Isaac, and the imprisonment of Joseph.
12 He used to tell you of the zealous Phinehas, and informed you of Ananias, Azarias, and Misael in the fire.
13 He used to glorify Daniel, who was in the den of lions, and pronounce him blessed.
14 He used to remind you of the scripture of Esaias, which says, "Even if you pass through the fire, it won't burn you."
15 He chanted to you David, the hymn writer, who says, "Many are the afflictions of the just."
16 He declared the proverbs of Solomon, who says, "He is a tree of life to all those who do His will."
17 He used to confirm what Ezekiel said: "Will these dry bones live?"
18 For he didn't forget the song which Moses taught, proclaiming, "I will kill, and I will make alive."
19 This is our life and the length of our days.
20 O that bitter, and yet not bitter, day when the bitter tyrant of the Greeks,

quenching fire with fire in his cruel
caldrons, brought with boiling rage the
seven sons of the daughter of Abraham to
the rack, and to all his torments!
21 He pierced the balls of their eyes, and
cut out their tongues, and put them to
death with varied tortures.
22 Therefore divine retribution pursued
and will pursue the pestilent wretch.
23 But the children of Abraham, with
their victorious mother, are assembled
together to the choir of their father,
having received pure and immortal souls
from God.
24 To him be glory forever and ever.
Amen.

The Good News According to Matthew

1 The book of the genealogy of Jesus
Christ,† the son of David, the son of
Abraham.
2 Abraham became the father of Isaac.
Isaac became the father of Jacob. Jacob
became the father of Judah and his
brothers.
3 Judah became the father of Perez and
Zerah by Tamar. Perez became the father
of Hezron. Hezron became the father of
Ram.
4 Ram became the father of
Amminadab. Amminadab became the
father of Nahshon. Nahshon became the
father of Salmon.
5 Salmon became the father of Boaz by
Rahab. Boaz became the father of Obed by
Ruth. Obed became the father of Jesse.
6 Jesse became the father of King David.
David the king‡ became the father of
Solomon by her who had been Uriah's
wife.
7 Solomon became the father of
Rehoboam. Rehoboam became the father
of Abijah. Abijah became the father of
Asa.
8 Asa became the father of Jehoshaphat.
Jehoshaphat became the father of Joram.
Joram became the father of Uzziah.
9 Uzziah became the father of Jotham.
Jotham became the father of Ahaz. Ahaz
became the father of Hezekiah.
10 Hezekiah became the father of
Manasseh. Manasseh became the father
of Amon. Amon became the father of
Josiah.
11 Josiah became the father of Jechoniah
and his brothers at the time of the exile to
Babylon.
12 After the exile to Babylon, Jechoniah
became the father of Shealtiel. Shealtiel
became the father of Zerubbabel.
13 Zerubbabel became the father of
Abiud. Abiud became the father of
Eliakim. Eliakim became the father of
Azor.
14 Azor became the father of Zadok.
Zadok became the father of Achim. Achim
became the father of Eliud.
15 Eliud became the father of Eleazar.
Eleazar became the father of Matthan.
Matthan became the father of Jacob.
16 Jacob became the father of Joseph, the
husband of Mary, from whom was born
Jesus,§ who is called Christ.
17 So all the generations from Abraham
to David are fourteen generations; from
David to the exile to Babylon fourteen
generations; and from the carrying away
to Babylon to the Christ, fourteen
generations.
18 Now the birth of Jesus Christ was like
this: After his mother, Mary, was engaged
to Joseph, before they came together, she
was found pregnant by the Holy Spirit.
19 Joseph, her husband, being a
righteous man, and not willing to make
her a public example, intended to put her
away secretly.
20 But when he thought about these
things, behold,† an angel of the Lord
appeared to him in a dream, saying,
"Joseph, son of David, don't be afraid to
take to yourself Mary as your wife, for
that which is conceived in her is of the
Holy Spirit.
21 She shall give birth to a son. You shall
name him Jesus,‡ for it is he who shall
save his people from their sins."
22 Now all this has happened that it
might be fulfilled which was spoken by
the Lord through the prophet, saying,
23 "Behold, the virgin shall be with child,
and shall give birth to a son.
They shall call his name Immanuel,"
which is, being interpreted, "God with
us."*
24 Joseph arose from his sleep, and did
as the angel of the Lord commanded him,
and took his wife to himself;
25 and didn't know her sexually until
she had given birth to her firstborn son.
He named him Jesus.

† **1:1** Messiah (Hebrew) and Christ (Greek) both mean "Anointed One" ‡ **1:6** NU omits "the king". § **1:16** "Jesus" means "Salvation". † **1:20** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. ‡ **1:21** "Jesus" means "Salvation". * **1:23** Isaiah 7:14

2

1 Now when Jesus was born in
Bethlehem of Judea in the days of King
Herod, behold, wise men† from the east
came to Jerusalem, saying,
2 "Where is he who is born King of the
Jews? For we saw his star in the east, and
have come to worship him."
3 When King Herod heard it, he was
troubled, and all Jerusalem with him.
4 Gathering together all the chief priests
and scribes of the people, he asked them
where the Christ would be born.
5 They said to him, "In Bethlehem of
Judea, for this is written through the
prophet,
6 'You Bethlehem, land of Judah,
are in no way least among the princes
of Judah;
for out of you shall come a governor
who shall shepherd my people,
Israel.' "*
7 Then Herod secretly called the wise
men, and learned from them exactly what
time the star appeared.
8 He sent them to Bethlehem, and said,
"Go and search diligently for the young
child. When you have found him, bring
me word, so that I also may come and
worship him."
9 They, having heard the king, went
their way; and behold, the star, which
they saw in the east, went before them
until it came and stood over where the
young child was.
10 When they saw the star, they rejoiced
with exceedingly great joy.
11 They came into the house and saw the
young child with Mary, his mother, and
they fell down and worshiped him.
Opening their treasures, they offered to
him gifts: gold, frankincense, and myrrh.
12 Being warned in a dream not to
return to Herod, they went back to their
own country another way.
13 Now when they had departed,
behold, an angel of the Lord appeared to
Joseph in a dream, saying, "Arise and take
the young child and his mother, and flee
into Egypt, and stay there until I tell you,
for Herod will seek the young child to
destroy him."
14 He arose and took the young child
and his mother by night and departed into
Egypt,
15 and was there until the death of
Herod, that it might be fulfilled which was
spoken by the Lord through the prophet,
saying, "Out of Egypt I called my son."*
16 Then Herod, when he saw that he was
mocked by the wise men, was exceedingly
angry, and sent out and killed all the male
children who were in Bethlehem and in
all the surrounding countryside, from two
years old and under, according to the
exact time which he had learned from the
wise men.
17 Then that which was spoken by
Jeremiah the prophet was fulfilled, saying,
18 "A voice was heard in Ramah,
lamentation, weeping and great
mourning,
Rachel weeping for her children;
she wouldn't be comforted,
because they are no more."*
19 But when Herod was dead, behold, an
angel of the Lord appeared in a dream to
Joseph in Egypt, saying,
20 "Arise and take the young child and
his mother, and go into the land of Israel,
for those who sought the young child's life
are dead."
21 He arose and took the young child
and his mother, and came into the land of
Israel.
22 But when he heard that Archelaus
was reigning over Judea in the place of his
father, Herod, he was afraid to go there.
Being warned in a dream, he withdrew
into the region of Galilee,
23 and came and lived in a city called
Nazareth; that it might be fulfilled which
was spoken through the prophets that he
will be called a Nazarene.

† **2:1** The word for "wise men" (magoi) can also mean teachers, scientists, physicians, astrologers, seers, interpreters of dreams, or sorcerers. * **2:6** Micah 5:2 * **2:15** Hosea 11:1 * **2:18** Jeremiah 31:15

3

1 In those days, John the Baptizer came,
preaching in the wilderness of Judea,
saying,
2 "Repent, for the Kingdom of Heaven is
at hand!"
3 For this is he who was spoken of by
Isaiah the prophet, saying,

"The voice of one crying in the wilderness,
make the way of the Lord ready!
Make his paths straight!"*

4 Now John himself wore clothing made
of camel's hair with a leather belt around
his waist. His food was locusts and wild
honey.
5 Then people from Jerusalem, all of
Judea, and all the region around the
Jordan went out to him.
6 They were baptized by him in the
Jordan, confessing their sins.
7 But when he saw many of the
Pharisees and Sadducees coming for his
baptism, he said to them, "You offspring of
vipers, who warned you to flee from the
wrath to come?
8 Therefore produce fruit worthy of
repentance!
9 Don't think to yourselves, 'We have
Abraham for our father,' for I tell you that
God is able to raise up children to
Abraham from these stones.
10 Even now the ax lies at the root of the
trees. Therefore every tree that doesn't
produce good fruit is cut down, and cast
into the fire.
11 "I indeed baptize you in water for
repentance, but he who comes after me is
mightier than I, whose sandals I am not
worthy to carry. He will baptize you in the
Holy Spirit.†
12 His winnowing fork is in his hand,
and he will thoroughly cleanse his
threshing floor. He will gather his wheat
into the barn, but the chaff he will burn
up with unquenchable fire."
13 Then Jesus came from Galilee to the
Jordan‡ to John, to be baptized by him.
14 But John would have hindered him,
saying, "I need to be baptized by you, and
you come to me?"
15 But Jesus, answering, said to him,
"Allow it now, for this is the fitting way for
us to fulfill all righteousness." Then he
allowed him.
16 Jesus, when he was baptized, went up
directly from the water: and behold, the
heavens were opened to him. He saw the
Spirit of God descending as a dove, and
coming on him.
17 Behold, a voice out of the heavens
said, "This is my beloved Son, with whom
I am well pleased."

4

1 Then Jesus was led up by the Spirit into
the wilderness to be tempted by the devil.
2 When he had fasted forty days and
forty nights, he was hungry afterward.
3 The tempter came and said to him, "If
you are the Son of God, command that
these stones become bread."
4 But he answered, "It is written, 'Man
shall not live by bread alone, but by every
word that proceeds out of God's mouth.' "*
5 Then the devil took him into the holy
city. He set him on the pinnacle of the
temple,
6 and said to him, "If you are the Son of
God, throw yourself down, for it is
written,
'He will command his angels concerning
you,' and,
'On their hands they will bear you up,
so that you don't dash your foot
against a stone.' "*
7 Jesus said to him, "Again, it is written,
'You shall not test the Lord, your God.' "*
8 Again, the devil took him to an
exceedingly high mountain, and showed
him all the kingdoms of the world and
their glory.
9 He said to him, "I will give you all of
these things, if you will fall down and
worship me."

* **3:3** Isaiah 40:3 † **3:11** TR and NU add "and with fire" ‡ **3:13** i.e., the Jordan River * **4:4** Deuteronomy 8:3
* **4:6** Psalms 91:11-12 * **4:7** Deuteronomy 6:16 † **4:10** TR and NU read "Go away" instead of "Get behind me"
* **4:10** Deuteronomy 6:13

10 Then Jesus said to him, "Get behind
me,† Satan! For it is written, 'You shall
worship the Lord your God, and you shall
serve him only.' " *
11 Then the devil left him, and behold,
angels came and served him.
12 Now when Jesus heard that John was
delivered up, he withdrew into Galilee.
13 Leaving Nazareth, he came and lived
in Capernaum, which is by the sea, in the
region of Zebulun and Naphtali,
14 that it might be fulfilled which was
spoken through Isaiah the prophet,
saying,
15 "The land of Zebulun and the land of
Naphtali,
toward the sea, beyond the Jordan,
Galilee of the Gentiles,
16 the people who sat in darkness saw a
great light;
to those who sat in the region and
shadow of death,
to them light has dawned."*
17 From that time, Jesus began to
preach, and to say, "Repent! For the
Kingdom of Heaven is at hand."
18 Walking by the sea of Galilee, he‡ saw
two brothers: Simon, who is called Peter,
and Andrew, his brother, casting a net
into the sea; for they were fishermen.
19 He said to them, "Come after me, and
I will make you fishers for men."
20 They immediately left their nets and
followed him.
21 Going on from there, he saw two
other brothers, James the son of Zebedee,
and John his brother, in the boat with
Zebedee their father, mending their nets.
He called them.
22 They immediately left the boat and
their father, and followed him.
23 Jesus went about in all Galilee,
teaching in their synagogues, preaching
the Good News of the Kingdom, and
healing every disease and every sickness
among the people.
24 The report about him went out into
all Syria. They brought to him all who
were sick, afflicted with various diseases
and torments, possessed with demons,
epileptics, and paralytics; and he healed
them.
25 Great multitudes from Galilee,
Decapolis, Jerusalem, Judea, and from
beyond the Jordan followed him.

5

1 Seeing the multitudes, he went up onto
the mountain. When he had sat down, his
disciples came to him.
2 He opened his mouth and taught them,
saying,
3 "Blessed are the poor in spirit,
for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven.*
4 Blessed are those who mourn,
for they shall be comforted.*
5 Blessed are the gentle,
for they shall inherit the earth.†*
6 Blessed are those who hunger and thirst
for righteousness,
for they shall be filled.
7 Blessed are the merciful,
for they shall obtain mercy.
8 Blessed are the pure in heart,
for they shall see God.
9 Blessed are the peacemakers,
for they shall be called children of
God.
10 Blessed are those who have been
persecuted for righteousness' sake,
for theirs is the Kingdom of Heaven.
11 "Blessed are you when people
reproach you, persecute you, and say all
kinds of evil against you falsely, for my
sake.
12 Rejoice, and be exceedingly glad, for
great is your reward in heaven. For that is
how they persecuted the prophets who
were before you.
13 "You are the salt of the earth, but if
the salt has lost its flavor, with what will it
be salted? It is then good for nothing, but
to be cast out and trodden under the feet
of men.
14 "You are the light of the world. A city
located on a hill can't be hidden.

* **4:16** Isaiah 9:1-2 ‡ **4:18** TR reads "Jesus" instead of "he" * **5:3** Isaiah 57:15; 66:2 * **5:4** Isaiah 61:2; 66:10,13
† **5:5** or, land. * **5:5** Psalms 37:11

15 Neither do you light a lamp and put it
under a measuring basket, but on a stand;
and it shines to all who are in the house.
16 Even so, let your light shine before
men, that they may see your good works
and glorify your Father who is in heaven.
17 "Don't think that I came to destroy the
law or the prophets. I didn't come to
destroy, but to fulfill.
18 For most certainly, I tell you, until
heaven and earth pass away, not even one
smallest letter‡ or one tiny pen stroke§
shall in any way pass away from the law,
until all things are accomplished.
19 Therefore, whoever shall break one
of these least commandments and teach
others to do so, shall be called least in the
Kingdom of Heaven; but whoever shall do
and teach them shall be called great in the
Kingdom of Heaven.
20 For I tell you that unless your
righteousness exceeds that of the scribes
and Pharisees, there is no way you will
enter into the Kingdom of Heaven.
21 "You have heard that it was said to the
ancient ones, 'You shall not murder;'* and
'Whoever murders will be in danger of
the judgment.'
22 But I tell you that everyone who is
angry with his brother without a cause †
will be in danger of the judgment.
Whoever says to his brother, 'Raca!' ‡ will
be in danger of the council. Whoever says,
'You fool!' will be in danger of the fire of
Gehenna.§
23 "If therefore you are offering your
gift at the altar, and there remember that
your brother has anything against you,
24 leave your gift there before the altar,
and go your way. First be reconciled to
your brother, and then come and offer
your gift.
25 Agree with your adversary quickly
while you are with him on the way; lest
perhaps the prosecutor deliver you to the
judge, and the judge deliver you to the
officer, and you be cast into prison.
26 Most certainly I tell you, you shall by
no means get out of there until you have
paid the last penny.†
27 "You have heard that it was said, ‡
'You shall not commit adultery;'*
28 but I tell you that everyone who gazes
at a woman to lust after her has
committed adultery with her already in
his heart.
29 If your right eye causes you to
stumble, pluck it out and throw it away
from you. For it is more profitable for you
that one of your members should perish
than for your whole body to be cast into
Gehenna.§
30 If your right hand causes you to
stumble, cut it off, and throw it away from
you. For it is more profitable for you that
one of your members should perish, than
for your whole body to be cast into
Gehenna.†
31 "It was also said, 'Whoever shall put
away his wife, let him give her a writing
of divorce,'*
32 but I tell you that whoever puts away
his wife, except for the cause of sexual
immorality, makes her an adulteress; and
whoever marries her when she is put
away commits adultery.
33 "Again you have heard that it was
said to the ancient ones, 'You shall not
make false vows, but shall perform to the
Lord your vows,'*
34 but I tell you, don't swear at all:
neither by heaven, for it is the throne of
God;
35 nor by the earth, for it is the footstool
of his feet; nor by Jerusalem, for it is the
city of the great King.
36 Neither shall you swear by your head,
for you can't make one hair white or
black.

‡ **5:18** literally, iota § **5:18** or, serif * **5:21** Exodus 20:13 † **5:22** NU omits "without a cause". ‡ **5:22** "Raca" is an Aramaic insult, related to the word for "empty" and conveying the idea of empty-headedness. § **5:22** or, Hell † **5:26** literally, kodrantes. A kodrantes was a small copper coin worth about 2 lepta (widow's mites)—not enough to buy very much of anything. ‡ **5:27** TR adds "to the ancients". * **5:27** Exodus 20:14 § **5:29** or, Hell † **5:30** or, Hell * **5:31** Deuteronomy 24:1 * **5:33** Numbers 30:2; Deuteronomy 23:21; Ecclesiastes 5:4

37 But let your ‘Yes’ be ‘Yes’ and your ‘No’
be ‘No.’ Whatever is more than these is of
the evil one.
38 “You have heard that it was said, ‘An
eye for an eye, and a tooth for a tooth.’*
39 But I tell you, don’t resist him who is
evil; but whoever strikes you on your
right cheek, turn to him the other also.
40 If anyone sues you to take away your
coat, let him have your cloak also.
41 Whoever compels you to go one mile,
go with him two.
42 Give to him who asks you, and don’t
turn away him who desires to borrow
from you.
43 “You have heard that it was said, ‘You
shall love your neighbor * and hate your
enemy.’‡
44 But I tell you, love your enemies, bless
those who curse you, do good to those
who hate you, and pray for those who
mistreat you and persecute you,
45 that you may be children of your
Father who is in heaven. For he makes his
sun to rise on the evil and the good, and
sends rain on the just and the unjust.
46 For if you love those who love you,
what reward do you have? Don’t even the
tax collectors do the same?
47 If you only greet your friends, what
more do you do than others? Don’t even
the tax collectors§ do the same?
48 Therefore you shall be perfect, just as
your Father in heaven is perfect.

6

1 “Be careful that you don’t do your
charitable giving† before men, to be seen
by them, or else you have no reward from
your Father who is in heaven.
2 Therefore, when you do merciful
deeds, don’t sound a trumpet before
yourself, as the hypocrites do in the
synagogues and in the streets, that they
may get glory from men. Most certainly I
tell you, they have received their reward.
3 But when you do merciful deeds, don’t
let your left hand know what your right
hand does,
4 so that your merciful deeds may be in
secret, then your Father who sees in
secret will reward you openly.
5 “When you pray, you shall not be as
the hypocrites, for they love to stand and
pray in the synagogues and in the corners
of the streets, that they may be seen by
men. Most certainly, I tell you, they have
received their reward.
6 But you, when you pray, enter into
your inner room, and having shut your
door, pray to your Father who is in secret;
and your Father who sees in secret will
reward you openly.
7 In praying, don’t use vain repetitions
as the Gentiles do; for they think that they
will be heard for their much speaking.
8 Therefore don’t be like them, for your
Father knows what things you need
before you ask him.
9 Pray like this:
“ ‘Our Father in heaven, may your name
be kept holy.
10 Let your Kingdom come.
Let your will be done on earth as it is
in heaven.
11 Give us today our daily bread.
12 Forgive us our debts,
as we also forgive our debtors.
13 Bring us not into temptation,
but deliver us from the evil one.
For yours is the Kingdom, the power, and
the glory forever. Amen.’‡
14 “For if you forgive men their
trespasses, your heavenly Father will also
forgive you.
15 But if you don’t forgive men their
trespasses, neither will your Father
forgive your trespasses.
16 “Moreover when you fast, don’t be
like the hypocrites, with sad faces. For
they disfigure their faces that they may be
seen by men to be fasting. Most certainly I
tell you, they have received their reward.

* **5:38** Exodus 21:24; Leviticus 24:20; Deuteronomy 19:21 * **5:43** Leviticus 19:18 ‡ **5:43** not in the Bible, but see Qumran Manual of Discipline Ix, 21-26 § **5:47** NU reads “Gentiles” instead of “tax collectors”. † **6:1** NU reads “acts of righteousness” instead of “charitable giving” ‡ **6:13** NU omits “For yours is the Kingdom, the power, and the glory forever. Amen.”

17 But you, when you fast, anoint your
head and wash your face,
18 so that you are not seen by men to be
fasting, but by your Father who is in
secret; and your Father, who sees in
secret, will reward you.
19 "Don't lay up treasures for yourselves
on the earth, where moth and rust
consume, and where thieves break
through and steal;
20 but lay up for yourselves treasures in
heaven, where neither moth nor rust
consume, and where thieves don't break
through and steal;
21 for where your treasure is, there your
heart will be also.
22 "The lamp of the body is the eye. If
therefore your eye is sound, your whole
body will be full of light.
23 But if your eye is evil, your whole
body will be full of darkness. If therefore
the light that is in you is darkness, how
great is the darkness!
24 "No one can serve two masters, for
either he will hate the one and love the
other, or else he will be devoted to one
and despise the other. You can't serve
both God and Mammon.
25 Therefore I tell you, don't be anxious
for your life: what you will eat, or what
you will drink; nor yet for your body,
what you will wear. Isn't life more than
food, and the body more than clothing?
26 See the birds of the sky, that they
don't sow, neither do they reap, nor
gather into barns. Your heavenly Father
feeds them. Aren't you of much more
value than they?
27 "Which of you by being anxious, can
add one moment§ to his lifespan?
28 Why are you anxious about clothing?
Consider the lilies of the field, how they
grow. They don't toil, neither do they spin,
29 yet I tell you that even Solomon in all
his glory was not dressed like one of these.
30 But if God so clothes the grass of the
field, which today exists and tomorrow is
thrown into the oven, won't he much
more clothe you, you of little faith?
31 "Therefore don't be anxious, saying,
'What will we eat?', 'What will we drink?'
or, 'With what will we be clothed?'
32 For the Gentiles seek after all these
things; for your heavenly Father knows
that you need all these things.
33 But seek first God's Kingdom and his
righteousness; and all these things will be
given to you as well.
34 Therefore don't be anxious for
tomorrow, for tomorrow will be anxious
for itself. Each day's own evil is sufficient.

7

1 "Don't judge, so that you won't be
judged.
2 For with whatever judgment you
judge, you will be judged; and with
whatever measure you measure, it will be
measured to you.
3 Why do you see the speck that is in
your brother's eye, but don't consider the
beam that is in your own eye?
4 Or how will you tell your brother, 'Let
me remove the speck from your eye,' and
behold, the beam is in your own eye?
5 You hypocrite! First remove the beam
out of your own eye, and then you can see
clearly to remove the speck out of your
brother's eye.
6 "Don't give that which is holy to the
dogs, neither throw your pearls before
the pigs, lest perhaps they trample them
under their feet, and turn and tear you to
pieces.
7 "Ask, and it will be given you. Seek,
and you will find. Knock, and it will be
opened for you.
8 For everyone who asks receives. He
who seeks finds. To him who knocks it
will be opened.
9 Or who is there among you who, if his
son asks him for bread, will give him a
stone?
10 Or if he asks for a fish, who will give
him a serpent?
11 If you then, being evil, know how to
give good gifts to your children, how
much more will your Father who is in

§ **6:27** literally, cubit

heaven give good things to those who ask him!
12 Therefore, whatever you desire for men to do to you, you shall also do to them; for this is the law and the prophets.
13 "Enter in by the narrow gate; for the gate is wide and the way is broad that leads to destruction, and there are many who enter in by it.
14 How† narrow is the gate and the way is restricted that leads to life! There are few who find it.
15 "Beware of false prophets, who come to you in sheep's clothing, but inwardly are ravening wolves.
16 By their fruits you will know them. Do you gather grapes from thorns or figs from thistles?
17 Even so, every good tree produces good fruit, but the corrupt tree produces evil fruit.
18 A good tree can't produce evil fruit, neither can a corrupt tree produce good fruit.
19 Every tree that doesn't grow good fruit is cut down and thrown into the fire.
20 Therefore by their fruits you will know them.
21 "Not everyone who says to me, 'Lord, Lord,' will enter into the Kingdom of Heaven, but he who does the will of my Father who is in heaven.
22 Many will tell me in that day, 'Lord, Lord, didn't we prophesy in your name, in your name cast out demons, and in your name do many mighty works?'
23 Then I will tell them, 'I never knew you. Depart from me, you who work iniquity.'
24 "Everyone therefore who hears these words of mine and does them, I will liken him to a wise man who built his house on the rock.
25 The rain came down, the floods came, and the winds blew and beat on that house; and it didn't fall, for it was founded on the rock.
26 Everyone who hears these words of mine and doesn't do them will be like a foolish man who built his house on the sand.
27 The rain came down, the floods came, and the winds blew and beat on that house; and it fell—and its fall was great."
28 When Jesus had finished saying these things, the multitudes were astonished at his teaching,
29 for he taught them with authority, and not like the scribes.

8

1 When he came down from the mountain, great multitudes followed him.
2 Behold, a leper came to him and worshiped him, saying, "Lord, if you want to, you can make me clean."
3 Jesus stretched out his hand and touched him, saying, "I want to. Be made clean." Immediately his leprosy was cleansed.
4 Jesus said to him, "See that you tell nobody; but go, show yourself to the priest, and offer the gift that Moses commanded, as a testimony to them."
5 When he came into Capernaum, a centurion came to him, asking him for help,
6 saying, "Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, grievously tormented."
7 Jesus said to him, "I will come and heal him."
8 The centurion answered, "Lord, I'm not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed.
9 For I am also a man under authority, having under myself soldiers. I tell this one, 'Go,' and he goes; and tell another, 'Come,' and he comes; and tell my servant, 'Do this,' and he does it."
10 When Jesus heard it, he marveled and said to those who followed, "Most certainly I tell you, I haven't found so great a faith, not even in Israel.
11 I tell you that many will come from the east and the west, and will sit down with Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob in the Kingdom of Heaven,
12 but the children of the Kingdom will be thrown out into the outer darkness. There will be weeping and gnashing of teeth."

† **7:14** TR reads "Because" instead of "How"

13 Jesus said to the centurion, "Go your
way. Let it be done for you as you have
believed." His servant was healed in that
hour.
14 When Jesus came into Peter's house,
he saw his wife's mother lying sick with a
fever.
15 He touched her hand, and the fever
left her. So she got up and served him.†
16 When evening came, they brought to
him many possessed with demons. He
cast out the spirits with a word, and
healed all who were sick,
17 that it might be fulfilled which was
spoken through Isaiah the prophet,
saying, "He took our infirmities and bore
our diseases."*
18 Now when Jesus saw great multitudes
around him, he gave the order to depart
to the other side.
19 A scribe came and said to him,
"Teacher, I will follow you wherever you
go."
20 Jesus said to him, "The foxes have
holes and the birds of the sky have nests,
but the Son of Man has nowhere to lay his
head."
21 Another of his disciples said to him,
"Lord, allow me first to go and bury my
father."
22 But Jesus said to him, "Follow me, and
leave the dead to bury their own dead."
23 When he got into a boat, his disciples
followed him.
24 Behold, a violent storm came up on
the sea, so much that the boat was covered
with the waves; but he was asleep.
25 The disciples came to him and woke
him up, saying, "Save us, Lord! We are
dying!"
26 He said to them, "Why are you
fearful, O you of little faith?" Then he got
up, rebuked the wind and the sea, and
there was a great calm.
27 The men marveled, saying, "What
kind of man is this, that even the wind
and the sea obey him?"
28 When he came to the other side, into
the country of the Gergesenes,‡ two
people possessed by demons met him
there, coming out of the tombs,
exceedingly fierce, so that nobody could
pass that way.
29 Behold, they cried out, saying, "What
do we have to do with you, Jesus, Son of
God? Have you come here to torment us
before the time?"
30 Now there was a herd of many pigs
feeding far away from them.
31 The demons begged him, saying, "If
you cast us out, permit us to go away into
the herd of pigs."
32 He said to them, "Go!"
They came out and went into the herd
of pigs; and behold, the whole herd of pigs
rushed down the cliff into the sea and
died in the water.
33 Those who fed them fled and went
away into the city and told everything,
including what happened to those who
were possessed with demons.
34 Behold, all the city came out to meet
Jesus. When they saw him, they begged
that he would depart from their borders.

9

1 He entered into a boat and crossed
over, and came into his own city.
2 Behold, they brought to him a man
who was paralyzed, lying on a bed. Jesus,
seeing their faith, said to the paralytic,
"Son, cheer up! Your sins are forgiven
you."
3 Behold, some of the scribes said to
themselves, "This man blasphemes."
4 Jesus, knowing their thoughts, said,
"Why do you think evil in your hearts?
5 For which is easier, to say, 'Your sins
are forgiven;' or to say, 'Get up, and walk'?
6 But that you may know that the Son of
Man has authority on earth to forgive
sins—" (then he said to the paralytic), "Get
up, and take up your mat, and go to your
house."
7 He arose and departed to his house.
8 But when the multitudes saw it, they
marveled and glorified God, who had
given such authority to men.

† **8:15** TR reads "them" instead of "him" * **8:17** Isaiah 53:4 ‡ **8:28** NU reads "Gadarenes"

9 As Jesus passed by from there, he saw
a man called Matthew sitting at the tax
collection office. He said to him, "Follow
me." He got up and followed him.
10 As he sat in the house, behold, many
tax collectors and sinners came and sat
down with Jesus and his disciples.
11 When the Pharisees saw it, they said
to his disciples, "Why does your teacher
eat with tax collectors and sinners?"
12 When Jesus heard it, he said to them,
"Those who are healthy have no need for
a physician, but those who are sick do.
13 But you go and learn what this
means: 'I desire mercy, and not
sacrifice,'* for I came not to call the
righteous, but sinners to repentance."†
14 Then John's disciples came to him,
saying, "Why do we and the Pharisees fast
often, but your disciples don't fast?"
15 Jesus said to them, "Can the friends of
the bridegroom mourn as long as the
bridegroom is with them? But the days
will come when the bridegroom will be
taken away from them, and then they will
fast.
16 No one puts a piece of unshrunk cloth
on an old garment; for the patch would
tear away from the garment, and a worse
hole is made.
17 Neither do people put new wine into
old wineskins, or else the skins would
burst, and the wine be spilled, and the
skins ruined. No, they put new wine into
fresh wineskins, and both are preserved."
18 While he told these things to them,
behold, a ruler came and worshiped him,
saying, "My daughter has just died, but
come and lay your hand on her, and she
will live."
19 Jesus got up and followed him, as did
his disciples.
20 Behold, a woman who had a
discharge of blood for twelve years came
behind him, and touched the fringe‡ of his
garment;
21 for she said within herself, "If I just
touch his garment, I will be made well."
22 But Jesus, turning around and seeing
her, said, "Daughter, cheer up! Your faith
has made you well." And the woman was
made well from that hour.
23 When Jesus came into the ruler's
house and saw the flute players and the
crowd in noisy disorder,
24 he said to them, "Make room, because
the girl isn't dead, but sleeping."
They were ridiculing him.
25 But when the crowd was sent out, he
entered in, took her by the hand, and the
girl arose.
26 The report of this went out into all
that land.
27 As Jesus passed by from there, two
blind men followed him, calling out and
saying, "Have mercy on us, son of David!"
28 When he had come into the house, the
blind men came to him. Jesus said to
them, "Do you believe that I am able to do
this?"
They told him, "Yes, Lord."
29 Then he touched their eyes, saying,
"According to your faith be it done to you."
30 Then their eyes were opened. Jesus
strictly commanded them, saying, "See
that no one knows about this."
31 But they went out and spread abroad
his fame in all that land.
32 As they went out, behold, a mute man
who was demon possessed was brought to
him.
33 When the demon was cast out, the
mute man spoke. The multitudes
marveled, saying, "Nothing like this has
ever been seen in Israel!"
34 But the Pharisees said, "By the prince
of the demons, he casts out demons."
35 Jesus went about all the cities and the
villages, teaching in their synagogues and
preaching the Good News of the Kingdom,
and healing every disease and every
sickness among the people.
36 But when he saw the multitudes, he
was moved with compassion for them
because they were harassed§ and
scattered, like sheep without a shepherd.

* **9:13** Hosea 6:6 † **9:13** NU omits "to repentance". ‡ **9:20** or, tassel § **9:36** TR reads "weary" instead of "harassed"

37 Then he said to his disciples, "The harvest indeed is plentiful, but the laborers are few.
38 Pray therefore that the Lord of the harvest will send out laborers into his harvest."

10

1 He called to himself his twelve disciples, and gave them authority over unclean spirits, to cast them out, and to heal every disease and every sickness.
2 Now the names of the twelve apostles are these. The first, Simon, who is called Peter; Andrew, his brother; James the son of Zebedee; John, his brother;
3 Philip; Bartholomew; Thomas; Matthew the tax collector; James the son of Alphaeus; Lebbaeus, who was also called† Thaddaeus;
4 Simon the Zealot; and Judas Iscariot, who also betrayed him.
5 Jesus sent these twelve out and commanded them, saying, "Don't go among the Gentiles, and don't enter into any city of the Samaritans.
6 Rather, go to the lost sheep of the house of Israel.
7 As you go, preach, saying, 'The Kingdom of Heaven is at hand!'
8 Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers,‡ and cast out demons. Freely you received, so freely give.
9 Don't take any gold, silver, or brass in your money belts.
10 Take no bag for your journey, neither two coats, nor sandals, nor staff: for the laborer is worthy of his food.
11 Into whatever city or village you enter, find out who in it is worthy, and stay there until you go on.
12 As you enter into the household, greet it.
13 If the household is worthy, let your peace come on it, but if it isn't worthy, let your peace return to you.
14 Whoever doesn't receive you or hear your words, as you go out of that house or that city, shake the dust off your feet.
15 Most certainly I tell you, it will be more tolerable for the land of Sodom and Gomorrah in the day of judgment than for that city.
16 "Behold, I send you out as sheep among wolves. Therefore be wise as serpents and harmless as doves.
17 But beware of men, for they will deliver you up to councils, and in their synagogues they will scourge you.
18 Yes, and you will be brought before governors and kings for my sake, for a testimony to them and to the nations.
19 But when they deliver you up, don't be anxious how or what you will say, for it will be given you in that hour what you will say.
20 For it is not you who speak, but the Spirit of your Father who speaks in you.
21 "Brother will deliver up brother to death, and the father his child. Children will rise up against parents and cause them to be put to death.
22 You will be hated by all men for my name's sake, but he who endures to the end will be saved.
23 But when they persecute you in this city, flee into the next, for most certainly I tell you, you will not have gone through the cities of Israel until the Son of Man has come.
24 "A disciple is not above his teacher, nor a servant above his lord.
25 It is enough for the disciple that he be like his teacher, and the servant like his lord. If they have called the master of the house Beelzebul,§ how much more those of his household!
26 Therefore don't be afraid of them, for there is nothing covered that will not be revealed, or hidden that will not be known.
27 What I tell you in the darkness, speak in the light; and what you hear whispered in the ear, proclaim on the housetops.
28 Don't be afraid of those who kill the body, but are not able to kill the soul. Rather, fear him who is able to destroy both soul and body in Gehenna.†

† **10:3** NU omits "Lebbaeus, who was also called" ‡ **10:8** TR adds "raise the dead," § **10:25** Literally, Lord of the Flies, or the devil † **10:28** or, Hell.

29 “Aren’t two sparrows sold for an
assarion coin?‡ Not one of them falls to
the ground apart from your Father’s will.
30 But the very hairs of your head are all
numbered.
31 Therefore don’t be afraid. You are of
more value than many sparrows.
32 Everyone therefore who confesses
me before men, I will also confess him
before my Father who is in heaven.
33 But whoever denies me before men, I
will also deny him before my Father who
is in heaven.
34 “Don’t think that I came to send peace
on the earth. I didn’t come to send peace,
but a sword.
35 For I came to set a man at odds
against his father, and a daughter against
her mother, and a daughter-in-law
against her mother-in-law.
36 A man’s foes will be those of his own
household.*
37 He who loves father or mother more
than me is not worthy of me; and he who
loves son or daughter more than me isn’t
worthy of me.
38 He who doesn’t take his cross and
follow after me isn’t worthy of me.
39 He who seeks his life will lose it; and
he who loses his life for my sake will find
it.
40 “He who receives you receives me,
and he who receives me receives him who
sent me.
41 He who receives a prophet in the
name of a prophet will receive a prophet’s
reward. He who receives a righteous man
in the name of a righteous man will
receive a righteous man’s reward.
42 Whoever gives one of these little ones
just a cup of cold water to drink in the
name of a disciple, most certainly I tell
you, he will in no way lose his reward.”

11

1 When Jesus had finished directing his
twelve disciples, he departed from there
to teach and preach in their cities.
2 Now when John heard in the prison
the works of Christ, he sent two of his
disciples
3 and said to him, “Are you he who
comes, or should we look for another?”
4 Jesus answered them, “Go and tell
John the things which you hear and see:
5 the blind receive their sight, the lame
walk, the lepers are cleansed, the deaf
hear,* the dead are raised up, and the
poor have good news preached to them.*
6 Blessed is he who finds no occasion for
stumbling in me.”
7 As these went their way, Jesus began
to say to the multitudes concerning John,
“What did you go out into the wilderness
to see? A reed shaken by the wind?
8 But what did you go out to see? A man
in soft clothing? Behold, those who wear
soft clothing are in kings’ houses.
9 But why did you go out? To see a
prophet? Yes, I tell you, and much more
than a prophet.
10 For this is he, of whom it is written,
‘Behold, I send my messenger before your
face, who will prepare your way before
you.’*
11 Most certainly I tell you, among those
who are born of women there has not
arisen anyone greater than John the
Baptizer; yet he who is least in the
Kingdom of Heaven is greater than he.
12 From the days of John the Baptizer
until now, the Kingdom of Heaven suffers
violence, and the violent take it by force.†
13 For all the prophets and the law
prophesied until John.
14 If you are willing to receive it, this is
Elijah, who is to come.
15 He who has ears to hear, let him hear.
16 “But to what shall I compare this
generation? It is like children sitting in
the marketplaces, who call to their
companions
17 and say, ‘We played the flute for you,
and you didn’t dance. We mourned for
you, and you didn’t lament.’

‡ **10:29** An assarion is a small coin worth one tenth of a drachma or a sixteenth of a denarius. An assarion is approximately the wages of one half hour of agricultural labor. * **10:36** Micah 7:6 * **11:5** Isaiah 35:5 * **11:5** Isaiah 61:1-4 * **11:10** Malachi 3:1 † **11:12** or, plunder it.

18 For John came neither eating nor
drinking, and they say, 'He has a demon.'
19 The Son of Man came eating and
drinking, and they say, 'Behold, a
gluttonous man and a drunkard, a friend
of tax collectors and sinners!' But wisdom
is justified by her children."‡

20 Then he began to denounce the cities
in which most of his mighty works had
been done, because they didn't repent.
21 "Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you,
Bethsaida! For if the mighty works had
been done in Tyre and Sidon which were
done in you, they would have repented
long ago in sackcloth and ashes.
22 But I tell you, it will be more tolerable
for Tyre and Sidon on the day of judgment
than for you.
23 You, Capernaum, who are exalted to
heaven, you will go down to Hades. § For
if the mighty works had been done in
Sodom which were done in you, it would
have remained until today.
24 But I tell you that it will be more
tolerable for the land of Sodom on the day
of judgment, than for you."

25 At that time, Jesus answered, "I thank
you, Father, Lord of heaven and earth,
that you hid these things from the wise
and understanding, and revealed them to
infants.
26 Yes, Father, for so it was well-pleasing
in your sight.
27 All things have been delivered to me
by my Father. No one knows the Son,
except the Father; neither does anyone
know the Father, except the Son and he to
whom the Son desires to reveal him.

28 "Come to me, all you who labor and
are heavily burdened, and I will give you
rest.
29 Take my yoke upon you and learn
from me, for I am gentle and humble in
heart; and you will find rest for your
souls.
30 For my yoke is easy, and my burden is
light."

12

1 At that time, Jesus went on the Sabbath
day through the grain fields. His disciples
were hungry and began to pluck heads of
grain and to eat.
2 But the Pharisees, when they saw it,
said to him, "Behold, your disciples do
what is not lawful to do on the Sabbath."
3 But he said to them, "Haven't you read
what David did when he was hungry, and
those who were with him:
4 how he entered into God's house and
ate the show bread, which was not lawful
for him to eat, nor for those who were
with him, but only for the priests?*
5 Or have you not read in the law that on
the Sabbath day the priests in the temple
profane the Sabbath and are guiltless?
6 But I tell you that one greater than the
temple is here.
7 But if you had known what this means,
'I desire mercy, and not sacrifice,'* you
wouldn't have condemned the guiltless.
8 For the Son of Man is Lord of the
Sabbath."
9 He departed from there and went into
their synagogue.
10 And behold, there was a man with a
withered hand. They asked him, "Is it
lawful to heal on the Sabbath day?" so
that they might accuse him.
11 He said to them, "What man is there
among you who has one sheep, and if this
one falls into a pit on the Sabbath day,
won't he grab on to it and lift it out?
12 Of how much more value then is a
man than a sheep! Therefore it is lawful
to do good on the Sabbath day."
13 Then he told the man, "Stretch out
your hand." He stretched it out; and it was
restored whole, just like the other.
14 But the Pharisees went out and
conspired against him, how they might
destroy him.
15 Jesus, perceiving that, withdrew from
there. Great multitudes followed him; and
he healed them all,
16 and commanded them that they
should not make him known,

‡ **11:19** NU reads "actions" instead of "children" § **11:23** or, Hell * **12:4** 1 Samuel 21:3-6 * **12:7** Hosea 6:6

17 that it might be fulfilled which was
spoken through Isaiah the prophet,
saying,
18 “Behold, my servant whom I have
chosen,
my beloved in whom my soul is well
pleased.
I will put my Spirit on him.
He will proclaim justice to the
nations.
19 He will not strive, nor shout,
neither will anyone hear his voice in
the streets.
20 He won’t break a bruised reed.
He won’t quench a smoking flax,
until he leads justice to victory.
21 In his name, the nations will
hope.”*
22 Then one possessed by a demon,
blind and mute, was brought to him; and
he healed him, so that the blind and mute
man both spoke and saw.
23 All the multitudes were amazed, and
said, “Can this be the son of David?”
24 But when the Pharisees heard it, they
said, “This man does not cast out demons
except by Beelzebul, the prince of the
demons.”
25 Knowing their thoughts, Jesus said to
them, “Every kingdom divided against
itself is brought to desolation, and every
city or house divided against itself will not
stand.
26 If Satan casts out Satan, he is divided
against himself. How then will his
kingdom stand?
27 If I by Beelzebul cast out demons, by
whom do your children cast them out?
Therefore they will be your judges.
28 But if I by the Spirit of God cast out
demons, then God’s Kingdom has come
upon you.
29 Or how can one enter into the house
of the strong man and plunder his goods,
unless he first bind the strong man? Then
he will plunder his house.
30 “He who is not with me is against me,
and he who doesn’t gather with me,
scatters.
31 Therefore I tell you, every sin and
blasphemy will be forgiven men, but the
blasphemy against the Spirit will not be
forgiven men.
32 Whoever speaks a word against the
Son of Man, it will be forgiven him; but
whoever speaks against the Holy Spirit, it
will not be forgiven him, either in this age,
or in that which is to come.
33 “Either make the tree good and its
fruit good, or make the tree corrupt and
its fruit corrupt; for the tree is known by
its fruit.
34 You offspring of vipers, how can you,
being evil, speak good things? For out of
the abundance of the heart, the mouth
speaks.
35 The good man out of his good
treasure† brings out good things, and the
evil man out of his evil treasure brings out
evil things.
36 I tell you that every idle word that
men speak, they will give account of it in
the day of judgment.
37 For by your words you will be
justified, and by your words you will be
condemned.”
38 Then certain of the scribes and
Pharisees answered, “Teacher, we want to
see a sign from you.”
39 But he answered them, “An evil and
adulterous generation seeks after a sign,
but no sign will be given to it but the sign
of Jonah the prophet.
40 For as Jonah was three days and three
nights in the belly of the huge fish, so will
the Son of Man be three days and three
nights in the heart of the earth.
41 The men of Nineveh will stand up in
the judgment with this generation and
will condemn it, for they repented at the
preaching of Jonah; and behold, someone
greater than Jonah is here.
42 The Queen of the South will rise up in
the judgment with this generation and
will condemn it, for she came from the
ends of the earth to hear the wisdom of
Solomon; and behold, someone greater
than Solomon is here.
43 “When an unclean spirit has gone out
of a man, he passes through waterless
places seeking rest, and doesn’t find it.

* **12:21** Isaiah 42:1-4 † **12:35** TR adds “of the heart”

44 Then he says, ‘I will return into my
house from which I came;’ and when he
has come back, he finds it empty, swept,
and put in order.
45 Then he goes and takes with himself
seven other spirits more evil than he is,
and they enter in and dwell there. The last
state of that man becomes worse than the
first. Even so will it be also to this evil
generation.”
46 While he was yet speaking to the
multitudes, behold, his mother and his
brothers stood outside, seeking to speak
to him.
47 One said to him, “Behold, your
mother and your brothers stand outside,
seeking to speak to you.”
48 But he answered him who spoke to
him, “Who is my mother? Who are my
brothers?”
49 He stretched out his hand toward his
disciples, and said, “Behold, my mother
and my brothers!
50 For whoever does the will of my
Father who is in heaven, he is my brother,
and sister, and mother.”

13

1 On that day Jesus went out of the
house and sat by the seaside.
2 Great multitudes gathered to him, so
that he entered into a boat and sat; and all
the multitude stood on the beach.
3 He spoke to them many things in
parables, saying, “Behold, a farmer went
out to sow.
4 As he sowed, some seeds fell by the
roadside, and the birds came and
devoured them.
5 Others fell on rocky ground, where
they didn’t have much soil, and
immediately they sprang up, because they
had no depth of earth.
6 When the sun had risen, they were
scorched. Because they had no root, they
withered away.
7 Others fell among thorns. The thorns
grew up and choked them.
8 Others fell on good soil and yielded
fruit: some one hundred times as much,
some sixty, and some thirty.
9 He who has ears to hear, let him hear.”
10 The disciples came, and said to him,
“Why do you speak to them in parables?”
11 He answered them, “To you it is given
to know the mysteries of the Kingdom of
Heaven, but it is not given to them.
12 For whoever has, to him will be given,
and he will have abundance; but whoever
doesn’t have, from him will be taken away
even that which he has.
13 Therefore I speak to them in parables,
because seeing they don’t see, and
hearing, they don’t hear, neither do they
understand.
14 In them the prophecy of Isaiah is
fulfilled, which says,
‘By hearing you will hear,
and will in no way understand;
Seeing you will see,
and will in no way perceive;
15 for this people’s heart has grown
callous,
their ears are dull of hearing,
and they have closed their eyes;
or else perhaps they might perceive with
their eyes,
hear with their ears,
understand with their heart,
and would turn again,
and I would heal them.’*
16 “But blessed are your eyes, for they
see; and your ears, for they hear.
17 For most certainly I tell you that many
prophets and righteous men desired to
see the things which you see, and didn’t
see them; and to hear the things which
you hear, and didn’t hear them.
18 “Hear, then, the parable of the farmer.

19 When anyone hears the word of the
Kingdom and doesn’t understand it, the
evil one comes and snatches away that
which has been sown in his heart. This is
what was sown by the roadside.
20 What was sown on the rocky places,
this is he who hears the word and
immediately with joy receives it;
21 yet he has no root in himself, but
endures for a while. When oppression or
persecution arises because of the word,
immediately he stumbles.

* **13:15** Isaiah 6:9-10

22 What was sown among the thorns,
this is he who hears the word, but the
cares of this age and the deceitfulness of
riches choke the word, and he becomes
unfruitful.
23 What was sown on the good ground,
this is he who hears the word and
understands it, who most certainly bears
fruit and produces, some one hundred
times as much, some sixty, and some
thirty."
24 He set another parable before them,
saying, "The Kingdom of Heaven is like a
man who sowed good seed in his field,
25 but while people slept, his enemy
came and sowed darnel weeds† also
among the wheat, and went away.
26 But when the blade sprang up and
produced grain, then the darnel weeds
appeared also.
27 The servants of the householder came
and said to him, 'Sir, didn't you sow good
seed in your field? Where did these
darnel weeds come from?'
28 "He said to them, 'An enemy has done
this.'
"The servants asked him, 'Do you want
us to go and gather them up?'
29 "But he said, 'No, lest perhaps while
you gather up the darnel weeds, you root
up the wheat with them.
30 Let both grow together until the
harvest, and in the harvest time I will tell
the reapers, "First, gather up the darnel
weeds, and bind them in bundles to burn
them; but gather the wheat into my
barn." ' "
31 He set another parable before them,
saying, "The Kingdom of Heaven is like a
grain of mustard seed which a man took,
and sowed in his field,
32 which indeed is smaller than all
seeds. But when it is grown, it is greater
than the herbs and becomes a tree, so that
the birds of the air come and lodge in its
branches."
33 He spoke another parable to them.
"The Kingdom of Heaven is like yeast
which a woman took and hid in three
measures‡ of meal, until it was all
leavened."
34 Jesus spoke all these things in
parables to the multitudes; and without a
parable, he didn't speak to them,
35 that it might be fulfilled which was
spoken through the prophet, saying,

"I will open my mouth in parables;
I will utter things hidden from the
foundation of the world."*

36 Then Jesus sent the multitudes away,
and went into the house. His disciples
came to him, saying, "Explain to us the
parable of the darnel weeds of the field."
37 He answered them, "He who sows the
good seed is the Son of Man,
38 the field is the world, the good seeds
are the children of the Kingdom, and the
darnel weeds are the children of the evil
one.
39 The enemy who sowed them is the
devil. The harvest is the end of the age,
and the reapers are angels.
40 As therefore the darnel weeds are
gathered up and burned with fire; so will
it be at the end of this age.
41 The Son of Man will send out his
angels, and they will gather out of his
Kingdom all things that cause stumbling
and those who do iniquity,
42 and will cast them into the furnace of
fire. There will be weeping and gnashing
of teeth.
43 Then the righteous will shine like the
sun in the Kingdom of their Father. He
who has ears to hear, let him hear.
44 "Again, the Kingdom of Heaven is like
treasure hidden in the field, which a man
found and hid. In his joy, he goes and sells
all that he has and buys that field.
45 "Again, the Kingdom of Heaven is like
a man who is a merchant seeking fine
pearls,
46 who having found one pearl of great
price, he went and sold all that he had and
bought it.

† **13:25** darnel is a weed grass (probably bearded darnel or lolium temulentum) that looks very much like wheat until it is mature, when the difference becomes very apparent. ‡ **13:33** literally, three sata. Three sata is about 39 liters or a bit more than a bushel * **13:35** Psalms 78:2

47 “Again, the Kingdom of Heaven is like
a dragnet that was cast into the sea and
gathered some fish of every kind,
48 which, when it was filled, fishermen
drew up on the beach. They sat down and
gathered the good into containers, but the
bad they threw away.
49 So it will be in the end of the world.§
The angels will come and separate the
wicked from among the righteous,
50 and will cast them into the furnace of
fire. There will be weeping and gnashing
of teeth.”
51 Jesus said to them, “Have you
understood all these things?”
They answered him, “Yes, Lord.”
52 He said to them, “Therefore every
scribe who has been made a disciple in
the Kingdom of Heaven is like a man who
is a householder, who brings out of his
treasure new and old things.”
53 When Jesus had finished these
parables, he departed from there.
54 Coming into his own country, he
taught them in their synagogue, so that
they were astonished and said, “Where
did this man get this wisdom and these
mighty works?
55 Isn’t this the carpenter’s son? Isn’t his
mother called Mary, and his brothers
James, Joses, Simon, and Judas?†
56 Aren’t all of his sisters with us?
Where then did this man get all of these
things?”
57 They were offended by him.
But Jesus said to them, “A prophet is not
without honor, except in his own country
and in his own house.”
58 He didn’t do many mighty works
there because of their unbelief.

14

1 At that time, Herod the tetrarch heard
the report concerning Jesus,
2 and said to his servants, “This is John
the Baptizer. He is risen from the dead.
That is why these powers work in him.”
3 For Herod had arrested John, bound
him, and put him in prison for the sake of
Herodias, his brother Philip’s wife.
4 For John said to him, “It is not lawful
for you to have her.”
5 When he would have put him to death,
he feared the multitude, because they
counted him as a prophet.
6 But when Herod’s birthday came, the
daughter of Herodias danced among them
and pleased Herod.
7 Therefore he promised with an oath to
give her whatever she should ask.
8 She, being prompted by her mother,
said, “Give me here on a platter the head
of John the Baptizer.”
9 The king was grieved, but for the sake
of his oaths and of those who sat at the
table with him, he commanded it to be
given,
10 and he sent and beheaded John in the
prison.
11 His head was brought on a platter and
given to the young lady; and she brought
it to her mother.
12 His disciples came, took the body, and
buried it. Then they went and told Jesus.
13 Now when Jesus heard this, he
withdrew from there in a boat to a
deserted place apart. When the
multitudes heard it, they followed him on
foot from the cities.
14 Jesus went out, and he saw a great
multitude. He had compassion on them
and healed their sick.
15 When evening had come, his disciples
came to him, saying, “This place is
deserted, and the hour is already late.
Send the multitudes away, that they may
go into the villages, and buy themselves
food.”
16 But Jesus said to them, “They don’t
need to go away. You give them
something to eat.”
17 They told him, “We only have here
five loaves and two fish.”
18 He said, “Bring them here to me.”
19 He commanded the multitudes to sit
down on the grass; and he took the five
loaves and the two fish, and looking up to
heaven, he blessed, broke and gave the
loaves to the disciples; and the disciples
gave to the multitudes.

§ **13:49** or, end of the age. † **13:55** or, Judah

20 They all ate and were filled. They took
up twelve baskets full of that which
remained left over from the broken
pieces.
21 Those who ate were about five
thousand men, in addition to women and
children.
22 Immediately Jesus made the disciples
get into the boat and go ahead of him to
the other side, while he sent the
multitudes away.
23 After he had sent the multitudes
away, he went up into the mountain by
himself to pray. When evening had come,
he was there alone.
24 But the boat was now in the middle of
the sea, distressed by the waves, for the
wind was contrary.
25 In the fourth watch of the night,†
Jesus came to them, walking on the sea.*
26 When the disciples saw him walking
on the sea, they were troubled, saying,
"It's a ghost!" and they cried out for fear.
27 But immediately Jesus spoke to them,
saying, "Cheer up! It is I! ‡ Don't be afraid."
28 Peter answered him and said, "Lord,
if it is you, command me to come to you
on the waters."
29 He said, "Come!"

Peter stepped down from the boat and
walked on the waters to come to Jesus.
30 But when he saw that the wind was
strong, he was afraid, and beginning to
sink, he cried out, saying, "Lord, save me!"
31 Immediately Jesus stretched out his
hand, took hold of him, and said to him,
"You of little faith, why did you doubt?"
32 When they got up into the boat, the
wind ceased.
33 Those who were in the boat came and
worshiped him, saying, "You are truly the
Son of God!"
34 When they had crossed over, they
came to the land of Gennesaret.
35 When the people of that place
recognized him, they sent into all that
surrounding region and brought to him
all who were sick;
36 and they begged him that they might
just touch the fringe§ of his garment. As
many as touched it were made whole.

15

1 Then Pharisees and scribes came to
Jesus from Jerusalem, saying,
2 "Why do your disciples disobey the
tradition of the elders? For they don't
wash their hands when they eat bread."
3 He answered them, "Why do you also
disobey the commandment of God
because of your tradition?
4 For God commanded, 'Honor your
father and your mother,'* and, 'He who
speaks evil of father or mother, let him be
put to death.'*
5 But you say, 'Whoever may tell his
father or his mother, "Whatever help you
might otherwise have gotten from me is a
gift devoted to God,"
6 he shall not honor his father or
mother.' You have made the
commandment of God void because of
your tradition.
7 You hypocrites! Well did Isaiah
prophesy of you, saying,
8 'These people draw near to me with their
mouth,
and honor me with their lips;
but their heart is far from me.
9 And they worship me in vain,
teaching as doctrine rules made by
men.' "*
10 He summoned the multitude, and
said to them, "Hear, and understand.
11 That which enters into the mouth
doesn't defile the man; but that which
proceeds out of the mouth, this defiles the
man."
12 Then the disciples came and said to
him, "Do you know that the Pharisees
were offended when they heard this
saying?"
13 But he answered, "Every plant which
my heavenly Father didn't plant will be
uprooted.

† **14:25** The night was equally divided into four watches, so the fourth watch is approximately 3:00 a.m. to sunrise.
* **14:25** See Job 9:8 ‡ **14:27** or, I AM! § **14:36** or, tassel * **15:4** Exodus 20:12; Deuteronomy 5:16 * **15:4** Exodus 21:17; Leviticus 20:9 * **15:9** Isaiah 29:13

14 Leave them alone. They are blind
guides of the blind. If the blind guide the
blind, both will fall into a pit."
15 Peter answered him, "Explain the
parable to us."
16 So Jesus said, "Do you also still not
understand?
17 Don't you understand that whatever
goes into the mouth passes into the belly
and then out of the body?
18 But the things which proceed out of
the mouth come out of the heart, and they
defile the man.
19 For out of the heart come evil
thoughts, murders, adulteries, sexual sins,
thefts, false testimony, and blasphemies.
20 These are the things which defile the
man; but to eat with unwashed hands
doesn't defile the man."
21 Jesus went out from there and
withdrew into the region of Tyre and
Sidon.
22 Behold, a Canaanite woman came out
from those borders and cried, saying,
"Have mercy on me, Lord, you son of
David! My daughter is severely possessed
by a demon!"
23 But he answered her not a word.
His disciples came and begged him,
saying, "Send her away; for she cries after
us."
24 But he answered, "I wasn't sent to
anyone but the lost sheep of the house of
Israel."
25 But she came and worshiped him,
saying, "Lord, help me."
26 But he answered, "It is not
appropriate to take the children's bread
and throw it to the dogs."
27 But she said, "Yes, Lord, but even the
dogs eat the crumbs which fall from their
masters' table."
28 Then Jesus answered her, "Woman,
great is your faith! Be it done to you even
as you desire." And her daughter was
healed from that hour.
29 Jesus departed from there and came
near to the sea of Galilee; and he went up
on the mountain and sat there.
30 Great multitudes came to him, having
with them the lame, blind, mute, maimed,
and many others, and they put them
down at his feet. He healed them,
31 so that the multitude wondered when
they saw the mute speaking, the injured
healed, the lame walking, and the blind
seeing—and they glorified the God of
Israel.
32 Jesus summoned his disciples and
said, "I have compassion on the
multitude, because they have continued
with me now three days and have nothing
to eat. I don't want to send them away
fasting, or they might faint on the way."
33 The disciples said to him, "Where
could we get so many loaves in a deserted
place as to satisfy so great a multitude?"
34 Jesus said to them, "How many loaves
do you have?"
They said, "Seven, and a few small fish."
35 He commanded the multitude to sit
down on the ground;
36 and he took the seven loaves and the
fish. He gave thanks and broke them, and
gave to the disciples, and the disciples to
the multitudes.
37 They all ate and were filled. They took
up seven baskets full of the broken pieces
that were left over.
38 Those who ate were four thousand
men, in addition to women and children.
39 Then he sent away the multitudes, got
into the boat, and came into the borders
of Magdala.

16

1 The Pharisees and Sadducees came,
and testing him, asked him to show them
a sign from heaven.
2 But he answered them, "When it is
evening, you say, 'It will be fair weather,
for the sky is red.'
3 In the morning, 'It will be foul weather
today, for the sky is red and threatening.'
Hypocrites! You know how to discern the
appearance of the sky, but you can't
discern the signs of the times!
4 An evil and adulterous generation
seeks after a sign, and there will be no
sign given to it, except the sign of the
prophet Jonah."
He left them and departed.

5 The disciples came to the other side
and had forgotten to take bread.
6 Jesus said to them, "Take heed and
beware of the yeast of the Pharisees and
Sadducees."
7 They reasoned among themselves,
saying, "We brought no bread."
8 Jesus, perceiving it, said, "Why do you
reason among yourselves, you of little
faith, because you have brought no
bread?
9 Don't you yet perceive or remember
the five loaves for the five thousand, and
how many baskets you took up,
10 or the seven loaves for the four
thousand, and how many baskets you
took up?
11 How is it that you don't perceive that I
didn't speak to you concerning bread? But
beware of the yeast of the Pharisees and
Sadducees."
12 Then they understood that he didn't
tell them to beware of the yeast of bread,
but of the teaching of the Pharisees and
Sadducees.
13 Now when Jesus came into the parts
of Caesarea Philippi, he asked his
disciples, saying, "Who do men say that I,
the Son of Man, am?"
14 They said, "Some say John the
Baptizer, some, Elijah, and others,
Jeremiah or one of the prophets."
15 He said to them, "But who do you say
that I am?"
16 Simon Peter answered, "You are the
Christ, the Son of the living God."
17 Jesus answered him, "Blessed are
you, Simon Bar Jonah, for flesh and blood
has not revealed this to you, but my
Father who is in heaven.
18 I also tell you that you are Peter,† and
on this rock ‡ I will build my assembly,
and the gates of Hades§ will not prevail
against it.
19 I will give to you the keys of the
Kingdom of Heaven, and whatever you
bind on earth will have been bound in
heaven; and whatever you release on
earth will have been released in heaven."
20 Then he commanded the disciples
that they should tell no one that he was
Jesus the Christ.
21 From that time, Jesus began to show
his disciples that he must go to Jerusalem
and suffer many things from the elders,
chief priests, and scribes, and be killed,
and the third day be raised up.
22 Peter took him aside and began to
rebuke him, saying, "Far be it from you,
Lord! This will never be done to you."
23 But he turned and said to Peter, "Get
behind me, Satan! You are a stumbling
block to me, for you are not setting your
mind on the things of God, but on the
things of men."
24 Then Jesus said to his disciples, "If
anyone desires to come after me, let him
deny himself, take up his cross, and follow
me.
25 For whoever desires to save his life
will lose it, and whoever will lose his life
for my sake will find it.
26 For what will it profit a man if he
gains the whole world and forfeits his
life? Or what will a man give in exchange
for his life?
27 For the Son of Man will come in the
glory of his Father with his angels, and
then he will give to everyone according to
his deeds.
28 Most certainly I tell you, there are
some standing here who will in no way
taste of death until they see the Son of
Man coming in his Kingdom."

17

1 After six days, Jesus took with him
Peter, James, and John his brother, and
brought them up into a high mountain by
themselves.
2 He was changed† before them. His face
shone like the sun, and his garments
became as white as the light.
3 Behold, Moses and Elijah appeared to
them talking with him.
4 Peter answered and said to Jesus,
"Lord, it is good for us to be here. If you
want, let's make three tents here: one for
you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah."

† **16:18** Peter's name, Petros in Greek, is the word for a specific rock or stone. ‡ **16:18** Greek, petra, a rock mass or bedrock. § **16:18** or, Hell † **17:2** or, transfigured

5 While he was still speaking, behold, a bright cloud overshadowed them. Behold, a voice came out of the cloud, saying, "This is my beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased. Listen to him."

6 When the disciples heard it, they fell on their faces, and were very afraid.
7 Jesus came and touched them and said, "Get up, and don't be afraid."
8 Lifting up their eyes, they saw no one, except Jesus alone.

9 As they were coming down from the mountain, Jesus commanded them, saying, "Don't tell anyone what you saw, until the Son of Man has risen from the dead."
10 His disciples asked him, saying, "Then why do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?"
11 Jesus answered them, "Elijah indeed comes first, and will restore all things;
12 but I tell you that Elijah has come already, and they didn't recognize him, but did to him whatever they wanted to. Even so the Son of Man will also suffer by them."
13 Then the disciples understood that he spoke to them of John the Baptizer.

14 When they came to the multitude, a man came to him, kneeling down to him and saying,
15 "Lord, have mercy on my son, for he is epileptic and suffers grievously; for he often falls into the fire, and often into the water.
16 So I brought him to your disciples, and they could not cure him."

17 Jesus answered, "Faithless and perverse generation! How long will I be with you? How long will I bear with you? Bring him here to me."
18 Jesus rebuked the demon, and it went out of him, and the boy was cured from that hour.

19 Then the disciples came to Jesus privately, and said, "Why weren't we able to cast it out?"
20 He said to them, "Because of your unbelief. For most certainly I tell you, if you have faith as a grain of mustard seed, you will tell this mountain, 'Move from here to there,' and it will move; and nothing will be impossible for you.
21 But this kind doesn't go out except by prayer and fasting." ‡
22 While they were staying in Galilee, Jesus said to them, "The Son of Man is about to be delivered up into the hands of men,
23 and they will kill him, and the third day he will be raised up."
They were exceedingly sorry.
24 When they had come to Capernaum, those who collected the didrachma coins§ came to Peter, and said, "Doesn't your teacher pay the didrachma?"
25 He said, "Yes."
When he came into the house, Jesus anticipated him, saying, "What do you think, Simon? From whom do the kings of the earth receive toll or tribute? From their children, or from strangers?"
26 Peter said to him, "From strangers."
Jesus said to him, "Therefore the children are exempt.
27 But, lest we cause them to stumble, go to the sea, cast a hook, and take up the first fish that comes up. When you have opened its mouth, you will find a stater coin.† Take that, and give it to them for me and you."

18

1 In that hour the disciples came to Jesus, saying, "Who then is greatest in the Kingdom of Heaven?"
2 Jesus called a little child to himself, and set him in the middle of them
3 and said, "Most certainly I tell you, unless you turn and become as little

‡ **17:21** NU omits verse 21. § **17:24** A didrachma is a Greek silver coin worth 2 drachmas, about as much as 2 Roman denarii, or about 2 days' wages. It was commonly used to pay the half-shekel temple tax, because 2 drachmas were worth one half shekel of silver. A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces. † **17:27** A stater is a silver coin equivalent to four Attic or two Alexandrian drachmas, or a Jewish shekel: just exactly enough to cover the half-shekel temple tax for two people. A shekel is about 10 grams or about 0.35 ounces, usually in the form of a silver coin.

children, you will in no way enter into the Kingdom of Heaven.
4 Whoever therefore humbles himself as this little child is the greatest in the Kingdom of Heaven.
5 Whoever receives one such little child in my name receives me,
6 but whoever causes one of these little ones who believe in me to stumble, it would be better for him if a huge millstone were hung around his neck and that he were sunk in the depths of the sea.
7 "Woe to the world because of occasions of stumbling! For it must be that the occasions come, but woe to that person through whom the occasion comes!
8 If your hand or your foot causes you to stumble, cut it off and cast it from you. It is better for you to enter into life maimed or crippled, rather than having two hands or two feet to be cast into the eternal fire.
9 If your eye causes you to stumble, pluck it out and cast it from you. It is better for you to enter into life with one eye, rather than having two eyes to be cast into the Gehenna† of fire.
10 See that you don't despise one of these little ones, for I tell you that in heaven their angels always see the face of my Father who is in heaven.
11 For the Son of Man came to save that which was lost.‡
12 "What do you think? If a man has one hundred sheep, and one of them goes astray, doesn't he leave the ninety-nine, go to the mountains, and seek that which has gone astray?
13 If he finds it, most certainly I tell you, he rejoices over it more than over the ninety-nine which have not gone astray.
14 Even so it is not the will of your Father who is in heaven that one of these little ones should perish.
15 "If your brother sins against you, go, show him his fault between you and him alone. If he listens to you, you have gained back your brother.
16 But if he doesn't listen, take one or two more with you, that at the mouth of two or three witnesses every word may be established.*
17 If he refuses to listen to them, tell it to the assembly. If he refuses to hear the assembly also, let him be to you as a Gentile or a tax collector.
18 Most certainly I tell you, whatever things you bind on earth will have been bound in heaven, and whatever things you release on earth will have been released in heaven.
19 Again, assuredly I tell you, that if two of you will agree on earth concerning anything that they will ask, it will be done for them by my Father who is in heaven.
20 For where two or three are gathered together in my name, there I am in the middle of them."
21 Then Peter came and said to him, "Lord, how often shall my brother sin against me, and I forgive him? Until seven times?"
22 Jesus said to him, "I don't tell you until seven times, but, until seventy times seven.
23 Therefore the Kingdom of Heaven is like a certain king who wanted to settle accounts with his servants.
24 When he had begun to settle, one was brought to him who owed him ten thousand talents.§
25 But because he couldn't pay, his lord commanded him to be sold, with his wife, his children, and all that he had, and payment to be made.
26 The servant therefore fell down and knelt before him, saying, 'Lord, have patience with me, and I will repay you all!'
27 The lord of that servant, being moved with compassion, released him and forgave him the debt.
28 "But that servant went out and found one of his fellow servants who owed him one hundred denarii,† and he grabbed him and took him by the throat, saying, 'Pay me what you owe!'

† **18:9** or, Hell ‡ **18:11** NU omits verse 11. * **18:16** Deuteronomy 19:15 § **18:24** Ten thousand talents (about 300 metric tons of silver) represents an extremely large sum of money, equivalent to about 60,000,000 denarii, where one denarius was typical of one day's wages for agricultural labor. † **18:28** 100 denarii was about one sixtieth of a talent, or about 500 grams (1.1 pounds) of silver.

29 “So his fellow servant fell down at his
feet and begged him, saying, ‘Have
patience with me, and I will repay you!’
30 He would not, but went and cast him
into prison until he should pay back that
which was due.
31 So when his fellow servants saw what
was done, they were exceedingly sorry,
and came and told their lord all that was
done.
32 Then his lord called him in and said to
him, ‘You wicked servant! I forgave you
all that debt because you begged me.
33 Shouldn’t you also have had mercy on
your fellow servant, even as I had mercy
on you?’
34 His lord was angry, and delivered
him to the tormentors until he should pay
all that was due to him.
35 So my heavenly Father will also do to
you, if you don’t each forgive your brother
from your hearts for his misdeeds.”

19

1 When Jesus had finished these words,
he departed from Galilee and came into
the borders of Judea beyond the Jordan.
2 Great multitudes followed him, and he
healed them there.
3 Pharisees came to him, testing him
and saying, “Is it lawful for a man to
divorce his wife for any reason?”
4 He answered, “Haven’t you read that
he who made them from the beginning
made them male and female,*
5 and said, ‘For this cause a man shall
leave his father and mother, and shall be
joined to his wife; and the two shall
become one flesh’?*
6 So that they are no more two, but one
flesh. What therefore God has joined
together, don’t let man tear apart.”
7 They asked him, “Why then did Moses
command us to give her a certificate of
divorce and divorce her?”
8 He said to them, “Moses, because of
the hardness of your hearts, allowed you
to divorce your wives, but from the
beginning it has not been so.
9 I tell you that whoever divorces his
wife, except for sexual immorality, and
marries another, commits adultery; and
he who marries her when she is divorced
commits adultery.”
10 His disciples said to him, “If this is the
case of the man with his wife, it is not
expedient to marry.”
11 But he said to them, “Not all men can
receive this saying, but those to whom it is
given.
12 For there are eunuchs who were born
that way from their mother’s womb, and
there are eunuchs who were made
eunuchs by men; and there are eunuchs
who made themselves eunuchs for the
Kingdom of Heaven’s sake. He who is able
to receive it, let him receive it.”
13 Then little children were brought to
him that he should lay his hands on them
and pray; and the disciples rebuked them.
14 But Jesus said, “Allow the little
children, and don’t forbid them to come to
me; for the Kingdom of Heaven belongs to
ones like these.”
15 He laid his hands on them, and
departed from there.
16 Behold, one came to him and said,
“Good teacher, what good thing shall I do,
that I may have eternal life?”
17 He said to him, “Why do you call me
good?† No one is good but one, that is,
God. But if you want to enter into life,
keep the commandments.”
18 He said to him, “Which ones?”
Jesus said, “ ‘You shall not murder.’ ‘You
shall not commit adultery.’ ‘You shall not
steal.’ ‘You shall not offer false testimony.’
19 ‘Honor your father and your
mother.’* And, ‘You shall love your
neighbor as yourself.’ ”*
20 The young man said to him, “All these
things I have observed from my youth.
What do I still lack?”
21 Jesus said to him, “If you want to be
perfect, go, sell what you have, and give to
the poor, and you will have treasure in
heaven; and come, follow me.”

* **19:4** Genesis 1:27 * **19:5** Genesis 2:24 † **19:17** So MT and TR. NU reads “Why do you ask me about what is good?” * **19:19** Exodus 20:12-16; Deuteronomy 5:16-20 * **19:19** Leviticus 19:18

22 But when the young man heard this,
he went away sad, for he was one who
had great possessions.
23 Jesus said to his disciples, "Most
certainly I say to you, a rich man will
enter into the Kingdom of Heaven with
difficulty.
24 Again I tell you, it is easier for a camel
to go through a needle's eye than for a
rich man to enter into God's Kingdom."
25 When the disciples heard it, they
were exceedingly astonished, saying,
"Who then can be saved?"
26 Looking at them, Jesus said, "With
men this is impossible, but with God all
things are possible."
27 Then Peter answered, "Behold, we
have left everything and followed you.
What then will we have?"
28 Jesus said to them, "Most certainly I
tell you that you who have followed me, in
the regeneration when the Son of Man
will sit on the throne of his glory, you also
will sit on twelve thrones, judging the
twelve tribes of Israel.
29 Everyone who has left houses, or
brothers, or sisters, or father, or mother,
or wife, or children, or lands, for my
name's sake, will receive one hundred
times, and will inherit eternal life.
30 But many will be last who are first,
and first who are last.

20

1 "For the Kingdom of Heaven is like a
man who was the master of a household,
who went out early in the morning to hire
laborers for his vineyard.
2 When he had agreed with the laborers
for a denarius† a day, he sent them into
his vineyard.
3 He went out about the third hour,‡ and
saw others standing idle in the
marketplace.
4 He said to them, 'You also go into the
vineyard, and whatever is right I will give
you.' So they went their way.
5 Again he went out about the sixth and
the ninth hour,§ and did likewise.
6 About the eleventh hour† he went out
and found others standing idle. He said to
them, 'Why do you stand here all day
idle?'
7 "They said to him, 'Because no one has
hired us.'
"He said to them, 'You also go into the
vineyard, and you will receive whatever
is right.'
8 "When evening had come, the lord of
the vineyard said to his manager, 'Call the
laborers and pay them their wages,
beginning from the last to the first.'
9 "When those who were hired at about
the eleventh hour came, they each
received a denarius.
10 When the first came, they supposed
that they would receive more; and they
likewise each received a denarius.
11 When they received it, they
murmured against the master of the
household,
12 saying, 'These last have spent one
hour, and you have made them equal to
us who have borne the burden of the day
and the scorching heat!'
13 "But he answered one of them,
'Friend, I am doing you no wrong. Didn't
you agree with me for a denarius?
14 Take that which is yours, and go your
way. It is my desire to give to this last just
as much as to you.
15 Isn't it lawful for me to do what I want
to with what I own? Or is your eye evil,
because I am good?'
16 So the last will be first, and the first
last. For many are called, but few are
chosen."
17 As Jesus was going up to Jerusalem,
he took the twelve disciples aside, and on
the way he said to them,
18 "Behold, we are going up to
Jerusalem, and the Son of Man will be
delivered to the chief priests and scribes,
and they will condemn him to death,

† **20:2** A denarius is a silver Roman coin worth 1/25th of a Roman aureus. This was a common wage for a day of farm labor. ‡ **20:3** Time was measured from sunrise to sunset, so the third hour would be about 9:00 a.m. § **20:5** noon and 3:00 p.m. † **20:6** 5:00 p.m.

19 and will hand him over to the Gentiles
to mock, to scourge, and to crucify; and
the third day he will be raised up."
20 Then the mother of the sons of
Zebedee came to him with her sons,
kneeling and asking a certain thing of
him.
21 He said to her, "What do you want?"
She said to him, "Command that these,
my two sons, may sit, one on your right
hand and one on your left hand, in your
Kingdom."
22 But Jesus answered, "You don't know
what you are asking. Are you able to
drink the cup that I am about to drink,
and be baptized with the baptism that I
am baptized with?"
They said to him, "We are able."
23 He said to them, "You will indeed
drink my cup, and be baptized with the
baptism that I am baptized with; but to sit
on my right hand and on my left hand is
not mine to give, but it is for whom it has
been prepared by my Father."
24 When the ten heard it, they were
indignant with the two brothers.
25 But Jesus summoned them, and said,
"You know that the rulers of the nations
lord it over them, and their great ones
exercise authority over them.
26 It shall not be so among you; but
whoever desires to become great among
you shall be‡ your servant.
27 Whoever desires to be first among
you shall be your bondservant,
28 even as the Son of Man came not to be
served, but to serve, and to give his life as
a ransom for many."
29 As they went out from Jericho, a great
multitude followed him.
30 Behold, two blind men sitting by the
road, when they heard that Jesus was
passing by, cried out, "Lord, have mercy
on us, you son of David!"
31 The multitude rebuked them, telling
them that they should be quiet, but they
cried out even more, "Lord, have mercy
on us, you son of David!"
32 Jesus stood still and called them, and
asked, "What do you want me to do for
you?"
33 They told him, "Lord, that our eyes
may be opened."
34 Jesus, being moved with compassion,
touched their eyes; and immediately their
eyes received their sight, and they
followed him.

21

1 When they came near to Jerusalem
and came to Bethsphage,† to the Mount of
Olives, then Jesus sent two disciples,
2 saying to them, "Go into the village
that is opposite you, and immediately you
will find a donkey tied, and a colt with
her. Untie them and bring them to me.
3 If anyone says anything to you, you
shall say, 'The Lord needs them,' and
immediately he will send them."
4 All this was done that it might be
fulfilled which was spoken through the
prophet, saying,
5 "Tell the daughter of Zion,
behold, your King comes to you,
humble, and riding on a donkey,
on a colt, the foal of a donkey."*
6 The disciples went and did just as Jesus
commanded them,
7 and brought the donkey and the colt
and laid their clothes on them; and he sat
on them.
8 A very great multitude spread their
clothes on the road. Others cut branches
from the trees and spread them on the
road.
9 The multitudes who went in front of
him, and those who followed, kept
shouting, "Hosanna‡ to the son of David!
Blessed is he who comes in the name of
the Lord! Hosanna in the highest!" *
10 When he had come into Jerusalem, all
the city was stirred up, saying, "Who is
this?"
11 The multitudes said, "This is the
prophet, Jesus, from Nazareth of Galilee."
12 Jesus entered into the temple of God
and drove out all of those who sold and

‡ **20:26** TR reads "let him be" instead of "shall be" † **21:1** TR & NU read "Bethphage" instead of "Bethsphage"
* **21:5** Zechariah 9:9 ‡ **21:9** "Hosanna" means "save us" or "help us, we pray". * **21:9** Psalms 118:26

bought in the temple, and overthrew the money changers' tables and the seats of those who sold the doves.
13 He said to them, "It is written, 'My house shall be called a house of prayer,'* but you have made it a den of robbers!"*
14 The lame and the blind came to him in the temple, and he healed them.
15 But when the chief priests and the scribes saw the wonderful things that he did, and the children who were crying in the temple and saying, "Hosanna to the son of David!" they were indignant,
16 and said to him, "Do you hear what these are saying?"
Jesus said to them, "Yes. Did you never read, 'Out of the mouth of children and nursing babies, you have perfected praise'?"*
17 He left them and went out of the city to Bethany, and camped there.
18 Now in the morning, as he returned to the city, he was hungry.
19 Seeing a fig tree by the road, he came to it and found nothing on it but leaves. He said to it, "Let there be no fruit from you forever!"
Immediately the fig tree withered away.
20 When the disciples saw it, they marveled, saying, "How did the fig tree immediately wither away?"
21 Jesus answered them, "Most certainly I tell you, if you have faith and don't doubt, you will not only do what was done to the fig tree, but even if you told this mountain, 'Be taken up and cast into the sea,' it would be done.
22 All things, whatever you ask in prayer, believing, you will receive."
23 When he had come into the temple, the chief priests and the elders of the people came to him as he was teaching, and said, "By what authority do you do these things? Who gave you this authority?"
24 Jesus answered them, "I also will ask you one question, which if you tell me, I likewise will tell you by what authority I do these things.
25 The baptism of John, where was it from? From heaven or from men?"
They reasoned with themselves, saying, "If we say, 'From heaven,' he will ask us, 'Why then did you not believe him?'
26 But if we say, 'From men,' we fear the multitude, for all hold John as a prophet."
27 They answered Jesus, and said, "We don't know."
He also said to them, "Neither will I tell you by what authority I do these things.
28 But what do you think? A man had two sons, and he came to the first, and said, 'Son, go work today in my vineyard.'
29 He answered, 'I will not,' but afterward he changed his mind, and went.
30 He came to the second, and said the same thing. He answered, 'I'm going, sir,' but he didn't go.
31 Which of the two did the will of his father?"
They said to him, "The first."
Jesus said to them, "Most certainly I tell you that the tax collectors and the prostitutes are entering into God's Kingdom before you.
32 For John came to you in the way of righteousness, and you didn't believe him; but the tax collectors and the prostitutes believed him. When you saw it, you didn't even repent afterward, that you might believe him.
33 "Hear another parable. There was a man who was a master of a household who planted a vineyard, set a hedge about it, dug a wine press in it, built a tower, leased it out to farmers, and went into another country.
34 When the season for the fruit came near, he sent his servants to the farmers to receive his fruit.
35 The farmers took his servants, beat one, killed another, and stoned another.
36 Again, he sent other servants more than the first; and they treated them the same way.
37 But afterward he sent to them his son, saying, 'They will respect my son.'
38 But the farmers, when they saw the son, said among themselves, 'This is the

* **21:13** Isaiah 56:7 * **21:13** Jeremiah 7:11 * **21:16** Psalms 8:2

heir. Come, let's kill him and seize his inheritance.'
39 So they took him and threw him out of the vineyard, then killed him.
40 When therefore the lord of the vineyard comes, what will he do to those farmers?"
41 They told him, "He will miserably destroy those miserable men, and will lease out the vineyard to other farmers who will give him the fruit in its season."
42 Jesus said to them, "Did you never read in the Scriptures,
'The stone which the builders rejected
was made the head of the corner.
This was from the Lord.
It is marvelous in our eyes'?*
43 "Therefore I tell you, God's Kingdom will be taken away from you and will be given to a nation producing its fruit.
44 He who falls on this stone will be broken to pieces, but on whomever it will fall, it will scatter him as dust."
45 When the chief priests and the Pharisees heard his parables, they perceived that he spoke about them.
46 When they sought to seize him, they feared the multitudes, because they considered him to be a prophet.

22

1 Jesus answered and spoke to them again in parables, saying,
2 "The Kingdom of Heaven is like a certain king, who made a wedding feast for his son,
3 and sent out his servants to call those who were invited to the wedding feast, but they would not come.
4 Again he sent out other servants, saying, 'Tell those who are invited, "Behold, I have prepared my dinner. My cattle and my fatlings are killed, and all things are ready. Come to the wedding feast!" '
5 But they made light of it, and went their ways, one to his own farm, another to his merchandise;
6 and the rest grabbed his servants, treated them shamefully, and killed them.
7 When the king heard that, he was angry, and sent his armies, destroyed those murderers, and burned their city.
8 "Then he said to his servants, 'The wedding is ready, but those who were invited weren't worthy.
9 Go therefore to the intersections of the highways, and as many as you may find, invite to the wedding feast.'
10 Those servants went out into the highways and gathered together as many as they found, both bad and good. The wedding was filled with guests.
11 "But when the king came in to see the guests, he saw there a man who didn't have on wedding clothing,
12 and he said to him, 'Friend, how did you come in here not wearing wedding clothing?' He was speechless.
13 Then the king said to the servants, 'Bind him hand and foot, take him away, and throw him into the outer darkness. That is where the weeping and grinding of teeth will be.'
14 For many are called, but few chosen."
15 Then the Pharisees went and took counsel how they might entrap him in his talk.
16 They sent their disciples to him, along with the Herodians, saying, "Teacher, we know that you are honest, and teach the way of God in truth, no matter whom you teach; for you aren't partial to anyone.
17 Tell us therefore, what do you think? Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar, or not?"
18 But Jesus perceived their wickedness, and said, "Why do you test me, you hypocrites?
19 Show me the tax money."
They brought to him a denarius.
20 He asked them, "Whose is this image and inscription?"
21 They said to him, "Caesar's."
Then he said to them, "Give therefore to Caesar the things that are Caesar's, and to God the things that are God's."
22 When they heard it, they marveled, and left him and went away.

* **21:42** Psalms 118:22-23

23 On that day Sadducees (those who say
that there is no resurrection) came to him.
They asked him,
24 saying, “Teacher, Moses said, ‘If a
man dies, having no children, his brother
shall marry his wife and raise up
offspring† for his brother.’
25 Now there were with us seven
brothers. The first married and died, and
having no offspring left his wife to his
brother.
26 In the same way, the second also, and
the third, to the seventh.
27 After them all, the woman died.
28 In the resurrection therefore, whose
wife will she be of the seven? For they all
had her.”
29 But Jesus answered them, “You are
mistaken, not knowing the Scriptures, nor
the power of God.
30 For in the resurrection they neither
marry nor are given in marriage, but are
like God’s angels in heaven.
31 But concerning the resurrection of
the dead, haven’t you read that which was
spoken to you by God, saying,
32 ‘I am the God of Abraham, and the
God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob’?* God
is not the God of the dead, but of the
living.”
33 When the multitudes heard it, they
were astonished at his teaching.
34 But the Pharisees, when they heard
that he had silenced the Sadducees,
gathered themselves together.
35 One of them, a lawyer, asked him a
question, testing him.
36 “Teacher, which is the greatest
commandment in the law?”
37 Jesus said to him, “ ‘You shall love the
Lord your God with all your heart, with all
your soul, and with all your mind.’*
38 This is the first and great
commandment.
39 A second likewise is this, ‘You shall
love your neighbor as yourself.’*
40 The whole law and the prophets
depend on these two commandments.”
41 Now while the Pharisees were
gathered together, Jesus asked them a
question,
42 saying, “What do you think of the
Christ? Whose son is he?”
They said to him, “Of David.”
43 He said to them, “How then does
David in the Spirit call him Lord, saying,
44 ‘The Lord said to my Lord,
sit on my right hand,
until I make your enemies a footstool
for your feet’?*
45 “If then David calls him Lord, how is
he his son?”
46 No one was able to answer him a
word, neither did any man dare ask him
any more questions from that day
forward.

23

1 Then Jesus spoke to the multitudes and
to his disciples,
2 saying, “The scribes and the Pharisees
sit on Moses’ seat.
3 All things therefore whatever they tell
you to observe, observe and do, but don’t
do their works; for they say, and don’t do.
4 For they bind heavy burdens that are
grievous to be borne, and lay them on
men’s shoulders; but they themselves will
not lift a finger to help them.
5 But they do all their works to be seen
by men. They make their phylacteries†
broad and enlarge the fringes‡ of their
garments,
6 and love the place of honor at feasts,
the best seats in the synagogues,
7 the salutations in the marketplaces,
and to be called ‘Rabbi, Rabbi’§ by men.
8 But you are not to be called ‘Rabbi’, for
one is your teacher, the Christ, and all of
you are brothers.
9 Call no man on the earth your father,
for one is your Father, he who is in
heaven.

† **22:24** or, seed * **22:32** Exodus 3:6 * **22:37** Deuteronomy 6:5 * **22:39** Leviticus 19:18 * **22:44** Psalms 110:1
† **23:5** phylacteries (tefillin in Hebrew) are small leather pouches that some Jewish men wear on their forehead and arm in prayer. They are used to carry a small scroll with some Scripture in it. See Deuteronomy 6:8. ‡ **23:5** or, tassels § **23:7** NU omits the second “Rabbi”.

10 Neither be called masters, for one is
your master, the Christ.
11 But he who is greatest among you will
be your servant.
12 Whoever exalts himself will be
humbled, and whoever humbles himself
will be exalted.
13 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,
hypocrites! For you devour widows’
houses, and as a pretense you make long
prayers. Therefore you will receive
greater condemnation.
14 “But woe to you, scribes and
Pharisees, hypocrites! Because you shut
up the Kingdom of Heaven against men;
for you don’t enter in yourselves, neither
do you allow those who are entering in to
enter.†
15 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,
hypocrites! For you travel around by sea
and land to make one proselyte; and when
he becomes one, you make him twice as
much a son of Gehenna‡ as yourselves.
16 “Woe to you, you blind guides, who
say, ‘Whoever swears by the temple, it is
nothing; but whoever swears by the gold
of the temple, he is obligated.’
17 You blind fools! For which is greater,
the gold or the temple that sanctifies the
gold?
18 And, ‘Whoever swears by the altar, it
is nothing; but whoever swears by the gift
that is on it, he is obligated.’
19 You blind fools! For which is greater,
the gift, or the altar that sanctifies the gift?
20 He therefore who swears by the altar,
swears by it and by everything on it.
21 He who swears by the temple, swears
by it and by him who has been living§ in
it.
22 He who swears by heaven, swears by
the throne of God and by him who sits on
it.
23 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,
hypocrites! For you tithe mint, dill, and
cumin,† and have left undone the
weightier matters of the law: justice,
mercy, and faith. But you ought to have
done these, and not to have left the other
undone.
24 You blind guides, who strain out a
gnat, and swallow a camel!
25 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,
hypocrites! For you clean the outside of
the cup and of the platter, but within they
are full of extortion and unrighteousness.‡
26 You blind Pharisee, first clean the
inside of the cup and of the platter, that its
outside may become clean also.
27 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,
hypocrites! For you are like whitened
tombs, which outwardly appear beautiful,
but inwardly are full of dead men’s bones
and of all uncleanness.
28 Even so you also outwardly appear
righteous to men, but inwardly you are
full of hypocrisy and iniquity.
29 “Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,
hypocrites! For you build the tombs of the
prophets and decorate the tombs of the
righteous,
30 and say, ‘If we had lived in the days of
our fathers, we wouldn’t have been
partakers with them in the blood of the
prophets.’
31 Therefore you testify to yourselves
that you are children of those who killed
the prophets.
32 Fill up, then, the measure of your
fathers.
33 You serpents, you offspring of vipers,
how will you escape the judgment of
Gehenna?§
34 Therefore, behold, I send to you
prophets, wise men, and scribes. Some of
them you will kill and crucify; and some of
them you will scourge in your synagogues
and persecute from city to city,
35 that on you may come all the
righteous blood shed on the earth, from
the blood of righteous Abel to the blood of
Zachariah son of Barachiah, whom you

† **23:14** Some Greek texts reverse the order of verses 13 and 14, and some omit verse 13, numbering verse 14 as 13. NU omits verse 14. ‡ **23:15** or, Hell § **23:21** NU reads “lives” † **23:23** cumin is an aromatic seed from Cuminum cyminum, resembling caraway in flavor and appearance. It is used as a spice. ‡ **23:25** TR reads “self-indulgence” instead of “unrighteousness” § **23:33** or, Hell

killed between the sanctuary and the
altar.
36 Most certainly I tell you, all these
things will come upon this generation.
37 “Jerusalem, Jerusalem, who kills the
prophets and stones those who are sent to
her! How often I would have gathered
your children together, even as a hen
gathers her chicks under her wings, and
you would not!
38 Behold, your house is left to you
desolate.
39 For I tell you, you will not see me
from now on, until you say, ‘Blessed is he
who comes in the name of the Lord!’ ”*

24

1 Jesus went out from the temple, and
was going on his way. His disciples came
to him to show him the buildings of the
temple.
2 But he answered them, “You see all of
these things, don’t you? Most certainly I
tell you, there will not be left here one
stone on another, that will not be thrown
down.”
3 As he sat on the Mount of Olives, the
disciples came to him privately, saying,
“Tell us, when will these things be? What
is the sign of your coming, and of the end
of the age?”
4 Jesus answered them, “Be careful that
no one leads you astray.
5 For many will come in my name,
saying, ‘I am the Christ,’ and will lead
many astray.
6 You will hear of wars and rumors of
wars. See that you aren’t troubled, for all
this must happen, but the end is not yet.
7 For nation will rise against nation, and
kingdom against kingdom; and there will
be famines, plagues, and earthquakes in
various places.
8 But all these things are the beginning
of birth pains.
9 “Then they will deliver you up to
oppression and will kill you. You will be
hated by all of the nations for my name’s
sake.
10 Then many will stumble, and will
deliver up one another, and will hate one
another.
11 Many false prophets will arise and
will lead many astray.
12 Because iniquity will be multiplied,
the love of many will grow cold.
13 But he who endures to the end will be
saved.
14 This Good News of the Kingdom will
be preached in the whole world for a
testimony to all the nations, and then the
end will come.
15 “When, therefore, you see the
abomination of desolation,* which was
spoken of through Daniel the prophet,
standing in the holy place (let the reader
understand),
16 then let those who are in Judea flee to
the mountains.
17 Let him who is on the housetop not go
down to take out the things that are in his
house.
18 Let him who is in the field not return
back to get his clothes.
19 But woe to those who are with child
and to nursing mothers in those days!
20 Pray that your flight will not be in the
winter nor on a Sabbath,
21 for then there will be great suffering,†
such as has not been from the beginning
of the world until now, no, nor ever will
be.
22 Unless those days had been
shortened, no flesh would have been
saved. But for the sake of the chosen ones,
those days will be shortened.
23 “Then if any man tells you, ‘Behold,
here is the Christ!’ or, ‘There!’ don’t
believe it.
24 For false christs and false prophets
will arise, and they will show great signs
and wonders, so as to lead astray, if
possible, even the chosen ones.
25 “Behold, I have told you beforehand.
26 “If therefore they tell you, ‘Behold, he
is in the wilderness,’ don’t go out; or
‘Behold, he is in the inner rooms,’ don’t
believe it.

* **23:39** Psalms 118:26 * **24:15** Daniel 9:27; 11:31; 12:11 † **24:21** or, oppression ‡ **24:28** or, eagles

27 For as the lightning flashes from the
east, and is seen even to the west, so will
the coming of the Son of Man be.
28 For wherever the carcass is, that is
where the vultures‡ gather together.

29 "But immediately after the suffering§
of those days, the sun will be darkened,
the moon will not give its light, the stars
will fall from the sky, and the powers of
the heavens will be shaken;*
30 and then the sign of the Son of Man
will appear in the sky. Then all the tribes
of the earth will mourn, and they will see
the Son of Man coming on the clouds of
the sky with power and great glory.
31 He will send out his angels with a
great sound of a trumpet, and they will
gather together his chosen ones from the
four winds, from one end of the sky to the
other.

32 "Now from the fig tree learn this
parable: When its branch has now
become tender and produces its leaves,
you know that the summer is near.
33 Even so you also, when you see all
these things, know that he is near, even at
the doors.
34 Most certainly I tell you, this
generation† will not pass away until all
these things are accomplished.
35 Heaven and earth will pass away, but
my words will not pass away.

36 "But no one knows of that day and
hour, not even the angels of heaven,‡ but
my Father only.
37 As the days of Noah were, so will the
coming of the Son of Man be.
38 For as in those days which were
before the flood they were eating and
drinking, marrying and giving in
marriage, until the day that Noah entered
into the ship,
39 and they didn't know until the flood
came and took them all away, so will the
coming of the Son of Man be.
40 Then two men will be in the field: one
will be taken and one will be left.
41 Two women will be grinding at the
mill: one will be taken and one will be left.

42 Watch therefore, for you don't know
in what hour your Lord comes.
43 But know this, that if the master of
the house had known in what watch of
the night the thief was coming, he would
have watched, and would not have
allowed his house to be broken into.
44 Therefore also be ready, for in an
hour that you don't expect, the Son of Man
will come.

45 "Who then is the faithful and wise
servant, whom his lord has set over his
household, to give them their food in due
season?
46 Blessed is that servant whom his lord
finds doing so when he comes.
47 Most certainly I tell you that he will
set him over all that he has.
48 But if that evil servant should say in
his heart, 'My lord is delaying his coming,'
49 and begins to beat his fellow servants,
and eat and drink with the drunkards,
50 the lord of that servant will come in a
day when he doesn't expect it and in an
hour when he doesn't know it,
51 and will cut him in pieces and
appoint his portion with the hypocrites.
That is where the weeping and grinding of
teeth will be.

25

1 "Then the Kingdom of Heaven will be
like ten virgins who took their lamps and
went out to meet the bridegroom.
2 Five of them were foolish, and five
were wise.
3 Those who were foolish, when they
took their lamps, took no oil with them,
4 but the wise took oil in their vessels
with their lamps.
5 Now while the bridegroom delayed,
they all slumbered and slept.

§ **24:29** or, oppression * **24:29** Isaiah 13:10; 34:4 ‡ **24:36** NU adds "nor the son" † **24:34** The word for "generation" (genea) can also be translated as "race." † **25:7** The end of the wick of an oil lamp needs to be cut off periodically to avoid having it become clogged with carbon deposits. The wick height is also adjusted so that the flame burns evenly and gives good light without producing a lot of smoke.

6 But at midnight there was a cry,
‘Behold! The bridegroom is coming! Come
out to meet him!’
7 Then all those virgins arose, and
trimmed their lamps.†
8 The foolish said to the wise, ‘Give us
some of your oil, for our lamps are going
out.’
9 But the wise answered, saying, ‘What
if there isn’t enough for us and you? You
go rather to those who sell, and buy for
yourselves.’
10 While they went away to buy, the
bridegroom came, and those who were
ready went in with him to the wedding
feast, and the door was shut.
11 Afterward the other virgins also
came, saying, ‘Lord, Lord, open to us.’
12 But he answered, ‘Most certainly I tell
you, I don’t know you.’
13 Watch therefore, for you don’t know
the day nor the hour in which the Son of
Man is coming.

14 “For it is like a man going into
another country, who called his own
servants and entrusted his goods to them.
15 To one he gave five talents,‡ to
another two, to another one, to each
according to his own ability. Then he
went on his journey.
16 Immediately he who received the five
talents went and traded with them, and
made another five talents.
17 In the same way, he also who got the
two gained another two.
18 But he who received the one talent
went away and dug in the earth and hid
his lord’s money.

19 “Now after a long time the lord of
those servants came, and settled accounts
with them.
20 He who received the five talents came
and brought another five talents, saying,
‘Lord, you delivered to me five talents.
Behold, I have gained another five talents
in addition to them.’

21 “His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good
and faithful servant. You have been
faithful over a few things, I will set you
over many things. Enter into the joy of
your lord.’

22 “He also who got the two talents came
and said, ‘Lord, you delivered to me two
talents. Behold, I have gained another two
talents in addition to them.’
23 “His lord said to him, ‘Well done, good
and faithful servant. You have been
faithful over a few things. I will set you
over many things. Enter into the joy of
your lord.’

24 “He also who had received the one
talent came and said, ‘Lord, I knew you
that you are a hard man, reaping where
you didn’t sow, and gathering where you
didn’t scatter.
25 I was afraid, and went away and hid
your talent in the earth. Behold, you have
what is yours.’

26 “But his lord answered him, ‘You
wicked and slothful servant. You knew
that I reap where I didn’t sow, and gather
where I didn’t scatter.
27 You ought therefore to have
deposited my money with the bankers,
and at my coming I should have received
back my own with interest.
28 Take away therefore the talent from
him and give it to him who has the ten
talents.
29 For to everyone who has will be
given, and he will have abundance, but
from him who doesn’t have, even that
which he has will be taken away.
30 Throw out the unprofitable servant
into the outer darkness, where there will
be weeping and gnashing of teeth.’

31 “But when the Son of Man comes in
his glory, and all the holy angels with him,
then he will sit on the throne of his glory.
32 Before him all the nations will be
gathered, and he will separate them one
from another, as a shepherd separates the
sheep from the goats.
33 He will set the sheep on his right
hand, but the goats on the left.
34 Then the King will tell those on his
right hand, ‘Come, blessed of my Father,
inherit the Kingdom prepared for you
from the foundation of the world;

‡ **25:15** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds (usually used to weigh silver unless otherwise specified)

35 for I was hungry and you gave me
food to eat. I was thirsty and you gave me
drink. I was a stranger and you took me
in.
36 I was naked and you clothed me. I
was sick and you visited me. I was in
prison and you came to me.'
37 "Then the righteous will answer him,
saying, 'Lord, when did we see you
hungry and feed you, or thirsty and give
you a drink?
38 When did we see you as a stranger
and take you in, or naked and clothe you?
39 When did we see you sick or in prison
and come to you?'
40 "The King will answer them, 'Most
certainly I tell you, because you did it to
one of the least of these my brothers,§ you
did it to me.'
41 Then he will say also to those on the
left hand, 'Depart from me, you cursed,
into the eternal fire which is prepared for
the devil and his angels;
42 for I was hungry, and you didn't give
me food to eat; I was thirsty, and you gave
me no drink;
43 I was a stranger, and you didn't take
me in; naked, and you didn't clothe me;
sick, and in prison, and you didn't visit
me.'
44 "Then they will also answer, saying,
'Lord, when did we see you hungry, or
thirsty, or a stranger, or naked, or sick, or
in prison, and didn't help you?'
45 "Then he will answer them, saying,
'Most certainly I tell you, because you
didn't do it to one of the least of these, you
didn't do it to me.'
46 These will go away into eternal
punishment, but the righteous into
eternal life."

26

1 When Jesus had finished all these
words, he said to his disciples,
2 "You know that after two days the
Passover is coming, and the Son of Man
will be delivered up to be crucified."
3 Then the chief priests, the scribes, and
the elders of the people were gathered
together in the court of the high priest,
who was called Caiaphas.
4 They took counsel together that they
might take Jesus by deceit and kill him.
5 But they said, "Not during the feast,
lest a riot occur among the people."
6 Now when Jesus was in Bethany, in the
house of Simon the leper,
7 a woman came to him having an
alabaster jar of very expensive ointment,
and she poured it on his head as he sat at
the table.
8 But when his disciples saw this, they
were indignant, saying, "Why this waste?
9 For this ointment might have been
sold for much and given to the poor."
10 However, knowing this, Jesus said to
them, "Why do you trouble the woman?
She has done a good work for me.
11 For you always have the poor with
you, but you don't always have me.
12 For in pouring this ointment on my
body, she did it to prepare me for burial.
13 Most certainly I tell you, wherever
this Good News is preached in the whole
world, what this woman has done will
also be spoken of as a memorial of her."
14 Then one of the twelve, who was
called Judas Iscariot, went to the chief
priests
15 and said, "What are you willing to
give me if I deliver him to you?" So they
weighed out for him thirty pieces of silver.
16 From that time he sought opportunity
to betray him.
17 Now on the first day of unleavened
bread, the disciples came to Jesus, saying
to him, "Where do you want us to prepare
for you to eat the Passover?"
18 He said, "Go into the city to a certain
person, and tell him, 'The Teacher says,
"My time is at hand. I will keep the
Passover at your house with my
disciples." ' "
19 The disciples did as Jesus commanded
them, and they prepared the Passover.
20 Now when evening had come, he was
reclining at the table with the twelve
disciples.

§ **25:40** The word for "brothers" here may be also correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

21 As they were eating, he said, “Most certainly I tell you that one of you will betray me.”
22 They were exceedingly sorrowful, and each began to ask him, “It isn’t me, is it, Lord?”
23 He answered, “He who dipped his hand with me in the dish will betray me.
24 The Son of Man goes even as it is written of him, but woe to that man through whom the Son of Man is betrayed! It would be better for that man if he had not been born.”
25 Judas, who betrayed him, answered, “It isn’t me, is it, Rabbi?”
He said to him, “You said it.”
26 As they were eating, Jesus took bread, gave thanks for† it, and broke it. He gave to the disciples and said, “Take, eat; this is my body.”
27 He took the cup, gave thanks, and gave to them, saying, “All of you drink it,
28 for this is my blood of the new covenant, which is poured out for many for the remission of sins.
29 But I tell you that I will not drink of this fruit of the vine from now on, until that day when I drink it anew with you in my Father’s Kingdom.”
30 When they had sung a hymn, they went out to the Mount of Olives.
31 Then Jesus said to them, “All of you will be made to stumble because of me tonight, for it is written, ‘I will strike the shepherd, and the sheep of the flock will be scattered.’*
32 But after I am raised up, I will go before you into Galilee.”
33 But Peter answered him, “Even if all will be made to stumble because of you, I will never be made to stumble.”
34 Jesus said to him, “Most certainly I tell you that tonight, before the rooster crows, you will deny me three times.”
35 Peter said to him, “Even if I must die with you, I will not deny you.” All of the disciples also said likewise.
36 Then Jesus came with them to a place called Gethsemane, and said to his disciples, “Sit here, while I go there and pray.”
37 He took with him Peter and the two sons of Zebedee, and began to be sorrowful and severely troubled.
38 Then Jesus said to them, “My soul is exceedingly sorrowful, even to death. Stay here and watch with me.”
39 He went forward a little, fell on his face, and prayed, saying, “My Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass away from me; nevertheless, not what I desire, but what you desire.”
40 He came to the disciples and found them sleeping, and said to Peter, “What, couldn’t you watch with me for one hour?
41 Watch and pray, that you don’t enter into temptation. The spirit indeed is willing, but the flesh is weak.”
42 Again, a second time he went away and prayed, saying, “My Father, if this cup can’t pass away from me unless I drink it, your desire be done.”
43 He came again and found them sleeping, for their eyes were heavy.
44 He left them again, went away, and prayed a third time, saying the same words.
45 Then he came to his disciples and said to them, “Are you still sleeping and resting? Behold, the hour is at hand, and the Son of Man is betrayed into the hands of sinners.
46 Arise, let’s be going. Behold, he who betrays me is at hand.”
47 While he was still speaking, behold, Judas, one of the twelve, came, and with him a great multitude with swords and clubs, from the chief priests and elders of the people.
48 Now he who betrayed him had given them a sign, saying, “Whoever I kiss, he is the one. Seize him.”
49 Immediately he came to Jesus, and said, “Greetings, Rabbi!” and kissed him.
50 Jesus said to him, “Friend, why are you here?”
Then they came and laid hands on Jesus, and took him.

† **26:26** TR reads “blessed” instead of “gave thanks for”
* **26:31** Zechariah 13:7

51 Behold, one of those who were with
Jesus stretched out his hand and drew his
sword, and struck the servant of the high
priest, and cut off his ear.
52 Then Jesus said to him, "Put your
sword back into its place, for all those
who take the sword will die by the sword.
53 Or do you think that I couldn't ask my
Father, and he would even now send me
more than twelve legions of angels?
54 How then would the Scriptures be
fulfilled that it must be so?"
55 In that hour Jesus said to the
multitudes, "Have you come out as
against a robber with swords and clubs to
seize me? I sat daily in the temple
teaching, and you didn't arrest me.
56 But all this has happened that the
Scriptures of the prophets might be
fulfilled."
Then all the disciples left him and fled.
57 Those who had taken Jesus led him
away to Caiaphas the high priest, where
the scribes and the elders were gathered
together.
58 But Peter followed him from a
distance to the court of the high priest,
and entered in and sat with the officers, to
see the end.
59 Now the chief priests, the elders, and
the whole council sought false testimony
against Jesus, that they might put him to
death,
60 and they found none. Even though
many false witnesses came forward, they
found none. But at last two false
witnesses came forward
61 and said, "This man said, 'I am able to
destroy the temple of God, and to build it
in three days.' "
62 The high priest stood up and said to
him, "Have you no answer? What is this
that these testify against you?"
63 But Jesus stayed silent. The high
priest answered him, "I adjure you by the
living God that you tell us whether you
are the Christ, the Son of God."
64 Jesus said to him, "You have said so.
Nevertheless, I tell you, after this you will
see the Son of Man sitting at the right
hand of Power, and coming on the clouds
of the sky."
65 Then the high priest tore his clothing,
saying, "He has spoken blasphemy! Why
do we need any more witnesses? Behold,
now you have heard his blasphemy.
66 What do you think?"
They answered, "He is worthy of death!"
67 Then they spat in his face and beat
him with their fists, and some slapped
him,
68 saying, "Prophesy to us, you Christ!
Who hit you?"
69 Now Peter was sitting outside in the
court, and a maid came to him, saying,
"You were also with Jesus, the Galilean!"
70 But he denied it before them all,
saying, "I don't know what you are talking
about."
71 When he had gone out onto the porch,
someone else saw him and said to those
who were there, "This man also was with
Jesus of Nazareth."
72 Again he denied it with an oath, "I
don't know the man."
73 After a little while those who stood by
came and said to Peter, "Surely you are
also one of them, for your speech makes
you known."
74 Then he began to curse and to swear,
"I don't know the man!"
Immediately the rooster crowed.
75 Peter remembered the word which
Jesus had said to him, "Before the rooster
crows, you will deny me three times."
Then he went out and wept bitterly.

27

1 Now when morning had come, all the
chief priests and the elders of the people
took counsel against Jesus to put him to
death.
2 They bound him, led him away, and
delivered him up to Pontius Pilate, the
governor.
3 Then Judas, who betrayed him, when
he saw that Jesus was condemned, felt
remorse, and brought back the thirty
pieces of silver to the chief priests and
elders,
4 saying, "I have sinned in that I
betrayed innocent blood."
But they said, "What is that to us? You
see to it."

5 He threw down the pieces of silver in
the sanctuary and departed. Then he
went away and hanged himself.
6 The chief priests took the pieces of
silver and said, “It’s not lawful to put them
into the treasury, since it is the price of
blood.”
7 They took counsel, and bought the
potter’s field with them to bury strangers
in.
8 Therefore that field has been called
“The Field of Blood” to this day.
9 Then that which was spoken through
Jeremiah† the prophet was fulfilled,
saying,
“They took the thirty pieces of silver,
the price of him upon whom a price
had been set,
whom some of the children of Israel
priced,
10 and they gave them for the potter’s field,
as the Lord commanded me.”*
11 Now Jesus stood before the governor;
and the governor asked him, saying, “Are
you the King of the Jews?”
Jesus said to him, “So you say.”
12 When he was accused by the chief
priests and elders, he answered nothing.
13 Then Pilate said to him, “Don’t you
hear how many things they testify against
you?”
14 He gave him no answer, not even one
word, so that the governor marveled
greatly.
15 Now at the feast the governor was
accustomed to release to the multitude
one prisoner whom they desired.
16 They had then a notable prisoner
called Barabbas.
17 When therefore they were gathered
together, Pilate said to them, “Whom do
you want me to release to you? Barabbas,
or Jesus who is called Christ?”
18 For he knew that because of envy
they had delivered him up.
19 While he was sitting on the judgment
seat, his wife sent to him, saying, “Have
nothing to do with that righteous man, for
I have suffered many things today in a
dream because of him.”
20 Now the chief priests and the elders
persuaded the multitudes to ask for
Barabbas and destroy Jesus.
21 But the governor answered them,
“Which of the two do you want me to
release to you?”
They said, “Barabbas!”
22 Pilate said to them, “What then shall I
do to Jesus who is called Christ?”
They all said to him, “Let him be
crucified!”
23 But the governor said, “Why? What
evil has he done?”
But they cried out exceedingly, saying,
“Let him be crucified!”
24 So when Pilate saw that nothing was
being gained, but rather that a
disturbance was starting, he took water
and washed his hands before the
multitude, saying, “I am innocent of the
blood of this righteous person. You see to
it.”
25 All the people answered, “May his
blood be on us and on our children!”
26 Then he released Barabbas to them,
but Jesus he flogged and delivered to be
crucified.
27 Then the governor’s soldiers took
Jesus into the Praetorium, and gathered
the whole garrison together against him.
28 They stripped him and put a scarlet
robe on him.
29 They braided a crown of thorns and
put it on his head, and a reed in his right
hand; and they kneeled down before him
and mocked him, saying, “Hail, King of the
Jews!”
30 They spat on him, and took the reed
and struck him on the head.
31 When they had mocked him, they
took the robe off him, and put his clothes
on him, and led him away to crucify him.
32 As they came out, they found a man of
Cyrene, Simon by name, and they
compelled him to go with them, that he
might carry his cross.
33 When they came to a place called
“Golgotha”, that is to say, “The place of a
skull,”

† **27:9** some manuscripts omit “Jeremiah” * **27:10** Zechariah 11:12-13; Jeremiah 19:1-13; 32:6-9

34 they gave him sour wine‡ to drink
mixed with gall.§ When he had tasted it,
he would not drink.
35 When they had crucified him, they
divided his clothing among them, casting
lots,†
36 and they sat and watched him there.
37 They set up over his head the
accusation against him written, “THIS IS
JESUS, THE KING OF THE JEWS.”
38 Then there were two robbers
crucified with him, one on his right hand
and one on the left.
39 Those who passed by blasphemed
him, wagging their heads
40 and saying, “You who destroy the
temple and build it in three days, save
yourself! If you are the Son of God, come
down from the cross!”
41 Likewise the chief priests also
mocking with the scribes, the Pharisees,‡
and the elders, said,
42 “He saved others, but he can’t save
himself. If he is the King of Israel, let him
come down from the cross now, and we
will believe in him.
43 He trusts in God. Let God deliver him
now, if he wants him; for he said, ‘I am the
Son of God.’ ”
44 The robbers also who were crucified
with him cast on him the same reproach.
45 Now from the sixth hour§ there was
darkness over all the land until the ninth
hour.†
46 About the ninth hour Jesus cried with
a loud voice, saying, “Eli, Eli, lima‡
sabachthani?” That is, “My God, my God,
why have you forsaken me?”*
47 Some of them who stood there, when
they heard it, said, “This man is calling
Elijah.”
48 Immediately one of them ran and
took a sponge, filled it with vinegar, put it
on a reed, and gave him a drink.
49 The rest said, “Let him be. Let’s see
whether Elijah comes to save him.”
50 Jesus cried again with a loud voice,
and yielded up his spirit.
51 Behold, the veil of the temple was
torn in two from the top to the bottom.
The earth quaked and the rocks were split.
52 The tombs were opened, and many
bodies of the saints who had fallen asleep
were raised;
53 and coming out of the tombs after his
resurrection, they entered into the holy
city and appeared to many.
54 Now the centurion and those who
were with him watching Jesus, when they
saw the earthquake and the things that
were done, were terrified, saying, “Truly
this was the Son of God!”
55 Many women were there watching
from afar, who had followed Jesus from
Galilee, serving him.
56 Among them were Mary Magdalene,
Mary the mother of James and Joses, and
the mother of the sons of Zebedee.
57 When evening had come, a rich man
from Arimathaea named Joseph, who
himself was also Jesus’ disciple, came.
58 This man went to Pilate and asked for
Jesus’ body. Then Pilate commanded the
body to be given up.
59 Joseph took the body and wrapped it
in a clean linen cloth
60 and laid it in his own new tomb,
which he had cut out in the rock. Then he
rolled a large stone against the door of the
tomb, and departed.
61 Mary Magdalene was there, and the
other Mary, sitting opposite the tomb.
62 Now on the next day, which was the
day after the Preparation Day, the chief
priests and the Pharisees were gathered
together to Pilate,
63 saying, “Sir, we remember what that
deceiver said while he was still alive:
‘After three days I will rise again.’
64 Command therefore that the tomb be
made secure until the third day, lest
perhaps his disciples come at night and
steal him away, and tell the people, ‘He is
risen from the dead;’ and the last
deception will be worse than the first.”

‡ **27:34** or, vinegar § **27:34** Gall is a bitter-tasting, dark green oil from a wormwood plant that is alcoholic in its effect. † **27:35** TR adds “that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet: ‘They divided my garments among them, and for my clothing they cast lots;’ ” [see Psalms 22:18 and John 19:24] ‡ **27:41** TR omits “the Pharisees”
§ **27:45** noon † **27:45** 3:00 p.m. ‡ **27:46** TR reads “lama” instead of “lima” * **27:46** Psalms 22:1

65 Pilate said to them, “You have a
guard. Go, make it as secure as you can.”
66 So they went with the guard and
made the tomb secure, sealing the stone.

28

1 Now after the Sabbath, as it began to
dawn on the first day of the week, Mary
Magdalene and the other Mary came to
see the tomb.
2 Behold, there was a great earthquake,
for an angel of the Lord descended from
the sky and came and rolled away the
stone from the door and sat on it.
3 His appearance was like lightning, and
his clothing white as snow.
4 For fear of him, the guards shook, and
became like dead men.
5 The angel answered the women,
“Don’t be afraid, for I know that you seek
Jesus, who has been crucified.
6 He is not here, for he has risen, just
like he said. Come, see the place where
the Lord was lying.
7 Go quickly and tell his disciples, ‘He
has risen from the dead, and behold, he
goes before you into Galilee; there you
will see him.’ Behold, I have told you.”
8 They departed quickly from the tomb
with fear and great joy, and ran to bring
his disciples word.
9 As they went to tell his disciples,
behold, Jesus met them, saying, “Rejoice!”
They came and took hold of his feet, and
worshiped him.
10 Then Jesus said to them, “Don’t be
afraid. Go tell my brothers † that they
should go into Galilee, and there they will
see me.”
11 Now while they were going, behold,
some of the guards came into the city and
told the chief priests all the things that
had happened.
12 When they were assembled with the
elders and had taken counsel, they gave a
large amount of silver to the soldiers,
13 saying, “Say that his disciples came by
night and stole him away while we slept.
14 If this comes to the governor’s ears,
we will persuade him and make you free
of worry.”
15 So they took the money and did as
they were told. This saying was spread
abroad among the Jews, and continues
until today.
16 But the eleven disciples went into
Galilee, to the mountain where Jesus had
sent them.
17 When they saw him, they bowed
down to him; but some doubted.
18 Jesus came to them and spoke to
them, saying, “All authority has been
given to me in heaven and on earth.
19 Go‡ and make disciples of all nations,
baptizing them in the name of the Father
and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit,
20 teaching them to observe all things
that I commanded you. Behold, I am with
you always, even to the end of the age.”
Amen.

† **28:10** The word for “brothers” here may be also correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.” ‡ **28:19** TR and NU add “therefore”

The Good News According to Mark

1 The beginning of the Good News of
Jesus Christ, the Son of God.
2 As it is written in the prophets,
"Behold,† I send my messenger before
your face,
who will prepare your way before
you:*
3 the voice of one crying in the wilderness,
'Make ready the way of the Lord!
Make his paths straight!' "*
4 John came baptizing‡ in the
wilderness and preaching the baptism of
repentance for forgiveness of sins.
5 All the country of Judea and all those
of Jerusalem went out to him. They were
baptized by him in the Jordan river,
confessing their sins.
6 John was clothed with camel's hair
and a leather belt around his waist. He ate
locusts and wild honey.
7 He preached, saying, "After me comes
he who is mightier than I, the strap of
whose sandals I am not worthy to stoop
down and loosen.
8 I baptized you in§ water, but he will
baptize you in the Holy Spirit."
9 In those days, Jesus came from
Nazareth of Galilee, and was baptized by
John in the Jordan.
10 Immediately coming up from the
water, he saw the heavens parting and the
Spirit descending on him like a dove.
11 A voice came out of the sky, "You are
my beloved Son, in whom I am well
pleased."
12 Immediately the Spirit drove him out
into the wilderness.
13 He was there in the wilderness forty
days, tempted by Satan. He was with the
wild animals; and the angels were serving
him.
14 Now after John was taken into
custody, Jesus came into Galilee,
preaching the Good News of God's
Kingdom,
15 and saying, "The time is fulfilled, and
God's Kingdom is at hand! Repent, and
believe in the Good News."
16 Passing along by the sea of Galilee, he
saw Simon and Andrew, the brother of
Simon, casting a net into the sea, for they
were fishermen.
17 Jesus said to them, "Come after me,
and I will make you into fishers for men."
18 Immediately they left their nets, and
followed him.
19 Going on a little further from there,
he saw James the son of Zebedee, and
John his brother, who were also in the
boat mending the nets.
20 Immediately he called them, and they
left their father, Zebedee, in the boat with
the hired servants, and went after him.
21 They went into Capernaum, and
immediately on the Sabbath day he
entered into the synagogue and taught.
22 They were astonished at his teaching,
for he taught them as having authority,
and not as the scribes.
23 Immediately there was in their
synagogue a man with an unclean spirit,
and he cried out,
24 saying, "Ha! What do we have to do
with you, Jesus, you Nazarene? Have you
come to destroy us? I know who you are:
the Holy One of God!"
25 Jesus rebuked him, saying, "Be quiet,
and come out of him!"
26 The unclean spirit, convulsing him
and crying with a loud voice, came out of
him.
27 They were all amazed, so that they
questioned among themselves, saying,
"What is this? A new teaching? For with
authority he commands even the unclean
spirits, and they obey him!"
28 The report of him went out
immediately everywhere into all the
region of Galilee and its surrounding area.

† **1:2** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
* **1:2** Malachi 3:1 * **1:3** Isaiah 40:3 ‡ **1:4** or, immersing § **1:8** The Greek word (en) translated here as "in" could also be translated as "with" in some contexts.

29 Immediately, when they had come
out of the synagogue, they came into the
house of Simon and Andrew, with James
and John.
30 Now Simon's wife's mother lay sick
with a fever, and immediately they told
him about her.
31 He came and took her by the hand
and raised her up. The fever left her
immediately,† and she served them.
32 At evening, when the sun had set,
they brought to him all who were sick and
those who were possessed by demons.
33 All the city was gathered together at
the door.
34 He healed many who were sick with
various diseases and cast out many
demons. He didn't allow the demons to
speak, because they knew him.
35 Early in the morning, while it was still
dark, he rose up and went out, and
departed into a deserted place, and
prayed there.
36 Simon and those who were with him
searched for him.
37 They found him and told him,
"Everyone is looking for you."
38 He said to them, "Let's go elsewhere
into the next towns, that I may preach
there also, because I came out for this
reason."
39 He went into their synagogues
throughout all Galilee, preaching and
casting out demons.
40 A leper came to him, begging him,
kneeling down to him, and saying to him,
"If you want to, you can make me clean."
41 Being moved with compassion, he
stretched out his hand, and touched him,
and said to him, "I want to. Be made
clean."
42 When he had said this, immediately
the leprosy departed from him and he
was made clean.
43 He strictly warned him and
immediately sent him out,
44 and said to him, "See that you say
nothing to anybody, but go show yourself
to the priest and offer for your cleansing
the things which Moses commanded, for a
testimony to them."
45 But he went out, and began to
proclaim it much, and to spread about the
matter, so that Jesus could no more
openly enter into a city, but was outside in
desert places. People came to him from
everywhere.

2

1 When he entered again into
Capernaum after some days, it was heard
that he was at home.
2 Immediately many were gathered
together, so that there was no more room,
not even around the door; and he spoke
the word to them.
3 Four people came, carrying a paralytic
to him.
4 When they could not come near to him
for the crowd, they removed the roof
where he was. When they had broken it
up, they let down the mat that the
paralytic was lying on.
5 Jesus, seeing their faith, said to the
paralytic, "Son, your sins are forgiven
you."
6 But there were some of the scribes
sitting there and reasoning in their hearts,
7 "Why does this man speak
blasphemies like that? Who can forgive
sins but God alone?"
8 Immediately Jesus, perceiving in his
spirit that they so reasoned within
themselves, said to them, "Why do you
reason these things in your hearts?
9 Which is easier, to tell the paralytic,
'Your sins are forgiven;' or to say, 'Arise,
and take up your bed, and walk'?
10 But that you may know that the Son of
Man has authority on earth to forgive
sins"—he said to the paralytic—
11 "I tell you, arise, take up your mat,
and go to your house."
12 He arose, and immediately took up
the mat and went out in front of them all,
so that they were all amazed and glorified
God, saying, "We never saw anything like
this!"
13 He went out again by the seaside. All
the multitude came to him, and he taught
them.

† **1:31** NU omits "immediately".

14 As he passed by, he saw Levi the son
of Alphaeus sitting at the tax office. He
said to him, "Follow me." And he arose
and followed him.
15 He was reclining at the table in his
house, and many tax collectors and
sinners sat down with Jesus and his
disciples, for there were many, and they
followed him.
16 The scribes and the Pharisees, when
they saw that he was eating with the
sinners and tax collectors, said to his
disciples, "Why is it that he eats and
drinks with tax collectors and sinners?"
17 When Jesus heard it, he said to them,
"Those who are healthy have no need for
a physician, but those who are sick. I
came not to call the righteous, but sinners
to repentance."
18 John's disciples and the Pharisees
were fasting, and they came and asked
him, "Why do John's disciples and the
disciples of the Pharisees fast, but your
disciples don't fast?"
19 Jesus said to them, "Can the
groomsmen fast while the bridegroom is
with them? As long as they have the
bridegroom with them, they can't fast.
20 But the days will come when the
bridegroom will be taken away from
them, and then they will fast in that day.
21 No one sews a piece of unshrunk
cloth on an old garment, or else the patch
shrinks and the new tears away from the
old, and a worse hole is made.
22 No one puts new wine into old
wineskins; or else the new wine will burst
the skins, and the wine pours out, and the
skins will be destroyed; but they put new
wine into fresh wineskins."
23 He was going on the Sabbath day
through the grain fields; and his disciples
began, as they went, to pluck the ears of
grain.
24 The Pharisees said to him, "Behold,
why do they do that which is not lawful on
the Sabbath day?"
25 He said to them, "Did you never read
what David did when he had need and
was hungry—he, and those who were with
him?
26 How he entered into God's house at
the time of Abiathar the high priest, and
ate the show bread, which is not lawful to
eat except for the priests, and gave also to
those who were with him?"
27 He said to them, "The Sabbath was
made for man, not man for the Sabbath.
28 Therefore the Son of Man is lord even
of the Sabbath."

3

1 He entered again into the synagogue,
and there was a man there whose hand
was withered.
2 They watched him, whether he would
heal him on the Sabbath day, that they
might accuse him.
3 He said to the man whose hand was
withered, "Stand up."
4 He said to them, "Is it lawful on the
Sabbath day to do good or to do harm? To
save a life or to kill?" But they were silent.
5 When he had looked around at them
with anger, being grieved at the
hardening of their hearts, he said to the
man, "Stretch out your hand." He
stretched it out, and his hand was
restored as healthy as the other.
6 The Pharisees went out, and
immediately conspired with the
Herodians against him, how they might
destroy him.
7 Jesus withdrew to the sea with his
disciples; and a great multitude followed
him from Galilee, from Judea,
8 from Jerusalem, from Idumaea,
beyond the Jordan, and those from
around Tyre and Sidon. A great
multitude, hearing what great things he
did, came to him.
9 He spoke to his disciples that a little
boat should stay near him because of the
crowd, so that they wouldn't press on him.
10 For he had healed many, so that as
many as had diseases pressed on him that
they might touch him.
11 The unclean spirits, whenever they
saw him, fell down before him and cried,
"You are the Son of God!"
12 He sternly warned them that they
should not make him known.

13 He went up into the mountain and
called to himself those whom he wanted,
and they went to him.
14 He appointed twelve, that they might
be with him, and that he might send them
out to preach
15 and to have authority to heal
sicknesses and to cast out demons:
16 Simon (to whom he gave the name
Peter);
17 James the son of Zebedee; and John,
the brother of James, (whom he called
Boanerges, which means, Sons of
Thunder);
18 Andrew; Philip; Bartholomew;
Matthew; Thomas; James, the son of
Alphaeus; Thaddaeus; Simon the Zealot;
19 and Judas Iscariot, who also betrayed
him.
Then he came into a house.
20 The multitude came together again,
so that they could not so much as eat
bread.
21 When his friends heard it, they went
out to seize him; for they said, "He is
insane."
22 The scribes who came down from
Jerusalem said, "He has Beelzebul," and,
"By the prince of the demons he casts out
the demons."
23 He summoned them and said to them
in parables, "How can Satan cast out
Satan?
24 If a kingdom is divided against itself,
that kingdom cannot stand.
25 If a house is divided against itself,
that house cannot stand.
26 If Satan has risen up against himself,
and is divided, he can't stand, but has an
end.
27 But no one can enter into the house of
the strong man to plunder unless he first
binds the strong man; then he will
plunder his house.
28 "Most certainly I tell you, all sins of
the descendants of man will be forgiven,
including their blasphemies with which
they may blaspheme;
29 but whoever may blaspheme against
the Holy Spirit never has forgiveness, but
is subject to eternal condemnation."†
30 —because they said, "He has an
unclean spirit."
31 His mother and his brothers came,
and standing outside, they sent to him,
calling him.
32 A multitude was sitting around him,
and they told him, "Behold, your mother,
your brothers, and your sisters‡ are
outside looking for you."
33 He answered them, "Who are my
mother and my brothers?"
34 Looking around at those who sat
around him, he said, "Behold, my mother
and my brothers!
35 For whoever does the will of God is
my brother, my sister, and mother."

4

1 Again he began to teach by the seaside.
A great multitude was gathered to him, so
that he entered into a boat in the sea and
sat down. All the multitude were on the
land by the sea.
2 He taught them many things in
parables, and told them in his teaching,
3 "Listen! Behold, the farmer went out
to sow.
4 As he sowed, some seed fell by the
road, and the birds† came and devoured
it.
5 Others fell on the rocky ground, where
it had little soil, and immediately it sprang
up, because it had no depth of soil.
6 When the sun had risen, it was
scorched; and because it had no root, it
withered away.
7 Others fell among the thorns, and the
thorns grew up and choked it, and it
yielded no fruit.
8 Others fell into the good ground and
yielded fruit, growing up and increasing.
Some produced thirty times, some sixty
times, and some one hundred times as
much."
9 He said, "Whoever has ears to hear, let
him hear."
10 When he was alone, those who were
around him with the twelve asked him
about the parables.
11 He said to them, "To you is given the
mystery of God's Kingdom, but to those

† **3:29** NU reads, guilty of an eternal sin. ‡ **3:32** TR omits "your sisters" † **4:4** TR adds "of the air"

who are outside, all things are done in parables,
12 that ‘seeing they may see and not perceive, and hearing they may hear and not understand, lest perhaps they should turn again, and their sins should be forgiven them.’ ”*
13 He said to them, “Don’t you understand this parable? How will you understand all of the parables?
14 The farmer sows the word.
15 The ones by the road are the ones where the word is sown; and when they have heard, immediately Satan comes and takes away the word which has been sown in them.
16 These in the same way are those who are sown on the rocky places, who, when they have heard the word, immediately receive it with joy.
17 They have no root in themselves, but are short-lived. When oppression or persecution arises because of the word, immediately they stumble.
18 Others are those who are sown among the thorns. These are those who have heard the word,
19 and the cares of this age, and the deceitfulness of riches, and the lusts of other things entering in choke the word, and it becomes unfruitful.
20 Those which were sown on the good ground are those who hear the word, accept it, and bear fruit, some thirty times, some sixty times, and some one hundred times.”
21 He said to them, “Is a lamp brought to be put under a basket ‡ or under a bed? Isn’t it put on a stand?
22 For there is nothing hidden except that it should be made known, neither was anything made secret but that it should come to light.
23 If any man has ears to hear, let him hear.”
24 He said to them, “Take heed what you hear. With whatever measure you measure, it will be measured to you; and more will be given to you who hear.
25 For whoever has, to him more will be given; and he who doesn’t have, even that which he has will be taken away from him.”
26 He said, “God’s Kingdom is as if a man should cast seed on the earth,
27 and should sleep and rise night and day, and the seed should spring up and grow, though he doesn’t know how.
28 For the earth bears fruit by itself: first the blade, then the ear, then the full grain in the ear.
29 But when the fruit is ripe, immediately he puts in the sickle, because the harvest has come.”
30 He said, “How will we liken God’s Kingdom? Or with what parable will we illustrate it?
31 It’s like a grain of mustard seed, which, when it is sown in the earth, though it is less than all the seeds that are on the earth,
32 yet when it is sown, grows up and becomes greater than all the herbs, and puts out great branches, so that the birds of the sky can lodge under its shadow.”
33 With many such parables he spoke the word to them, as they were able to hear it.
34 Without a parable he didn’t speak to them; but privately to his own disciples he explained everything.
35 On that day, when evening had come, he said to them, “Let’s go over to the other side.”
36 Leaving the multitude, they took him with them, even as he was, in the boat. Other small boats were also with him.
37 A big wind storm arose, and the waves beat into the boat, so much that the boat was already filled.
38 He himself was in the stern, asleep on the cushion; and they woke him up and asked him, “Teacher, don’t you care that we are dying?”
39 He awoke and rebuked the wind, and said to the sea, “Peace! Be still!” The wind ceased and there was a great calm.
40 He said to them, “Why are you so afraid? How is it that you have no faith?”

* **4:12** Isaiah 6:9-10 ‡ **4:21** literally, a modion, a dry measuring basket containing about a peck (about 9 liters)

41 They were greatly afraid and said to
one another, “Who then is this, that even
the wind and the sea obey him?”

5

1 They came to the other side of the sea,
into the country of the Gadarenes.
2 When he had come out of the boat,
immediately a man with an unclean spirit
met him out of the tombs.
3 He lived in the tombs. Nobody could
bind him any more, not even with chains,
4 because he had been often bound with
fetters and chains, and the chains had
been torn apart by him, and the fetters
broken in pieces. Nobody had the
strength to tame him.
5 Always, night and day, in the tombs
and in the mountains, he was crying out,
and cutting himself with stones.
6 When he saw Jesus from afar, he ran
and bowed down to him,
7 and crying out with a loud voice, he
said, “What have I to do with you, Jesus,
you Son of the Most High God? I adjure
you by God, don’t torment me.”
8 For he said to him, “Come out of the
man, you unclean spirit!”
9 He asked him, “What is your name?”
He said to him, “My name is Legion, for
we are many.”
10 He begged him much that he would
not send them away out of the country.
11 Now on the mountainside there was a
great herd of pigs feeding.
12 All the demons begged him, saying,
“Send us into the pigs, that we may enter
into them.”
13 At once Jesus gave them permission.
The unclean spirits came out and entered
into the pigs. The herd of about two
thousand rushed down the steep bank
into the sea, and they were drowned in
the sea.
14 Those who fed the pigs fled, and told
it in the city and in the country.
The people came to see what it was that
had happened.
15 They came to Jesus, and saw him who
had been possessed by demons sitting,
clothed, and in his right mind, even him
who had the legion; and they were afraid.
16 Those who saw it declared to them
what happened to him who was
possessed by demons, and about the pigs.
17 They began to beg him to depart from
their region.
18 As he was entering into the boat, he
who had been possessed by demons
begged him that he might be with him.
19 He didn’t allow him, but said to him,
“Go to your house, to your friends, and tell
them what great things the Lord has done
for you and how he had mercy on you.”
20 He went his way, and began to
proclaim in Decapolis how Jesus had done
great things for him, and everyone
marveled.
21 When Jesus had crossed back over in
the boat to the other side, a great
multitude was gathered to him; and he
was by the sea.
22 Behold, one of the rulers of the
synagogue, Jairus by name, came; and
seeing him, he fell at his feet
23 and begged him much, saying, “My
little daughter is at the point of death.
Please come and lay your hands on her,
that she may be made healthy, and live.”
24 He went with him, and a great
multitude followed him, and they pressed
upon him on all sides.
25 A certain woman who had a
discharge of blood for twelve years,
26 and had suffered many things by
many physicians, and had spent all that
she had, and was no better, but rather
grew worse,
27 having heard the things concerning
Jesus, came up behind him in the crowd
and touched his clothes.
28 For she said, “If I just touch his
clothes, I will be made well.”
29 Immediately the flow of her blood
was dried up, and she felt in her body that
she was healed of her affliction.
30 Immediately Jesus, perceiving in
himself that the power had gone out from
him, turned around in the crowd and
asked, “Who touched my clothes?”
31 His disciples said to him, “You see the
multitude pressing against you, and you
say, ‘Who touched me?’ ”

32 He looked around to see her who had
done this thing.
33 But the woman, fearing and
trembling, knowing what had been done
to her, came and fell down before him,
and told him all the truth.
34 He said to her, "Daughter, your faith
has made you well. Go in peace, and be
cured of your disease."
35 While he was still speaking, people
came from the synagogue ruler's house,
saying, "Your daughter is dead. Why
bother the Teacher any more?"
36 But Jesus, when he heard the message
spoken, immediately said to the ruler of
the synagogue, "Don't be afraid, only
believe."
37 He allowed no one to follow him
except Peter, James, and John the brother
of James.
38 He came to the synagogue ruler's
house, and he saw an uproar, weeping,
and great wailing.
39 When he had entered in, he said to
them, "Why do you make an uproar and
weep? The child is not dead, but is asleep."
40 They ridiculed him. But he, having
put them all out, took the father of the
child, her mother, and those who were
with him, and went in where the child
was lying.
41 Taking the child by the hand, he said
to her, "Talitha cumi!" which means,
being interpreted, "Girl, I tell you, get up!"
42 Immediately the girl rose up and
walked, for she was twelve years old.
They were amazed with great
amazement.
43 He strictly ordered them that no one
should know this, and commanded that
something should be given to her to eat.

6

1 He went out from there. He came into
his own country, and his disciples
followed him.
2 When the Sabbath had come, he began
to teach in the synagogue, and many
hearing him were astonished, saying,
"Where did this man get these things?"
and, "What is the wisdom that is given to
this man, that such mighty works come
about by his hands?
3 Isn't this the carpenter, the son of
Mary and brother of James, Joses, Judah,
and Simon? Aren't his sisters here with
us?" So they were offended at him.
4 Jesus said to them, "A prophet is not
without honor, except in his own country,
and among his own relatives, and in his
own house."
5 He could do no mighty work there,
except that he laid his hands on a few sick
people and healed them.
6 He marveled because of their unbelief.
He went around the villages teaching.
7 He called to himself the twelve, and
began to send them out two by two; and
he gave them authority over the unclean
spirits.
8 He commanded them that they should
take nothing for their journey, except a
staff only: no bread, no wallet, no money
in their purse,
9 but to wear sandals, and not put on
two tunics.
10 He said to them, "Wherever you enter
into a house, stay there until you depart
from there.
11 Whoever will not receive you nor
hear you, as you depart from there, shake
off the dust that is under your feet for a
testimony against them. Assuredly, I tell
you, it will be more tolerable for Sodom
and Gomorrah in the day of judgment
than for that city!"
12 They went out and preached that
people should repent.
13 They cast out many demons, and
anointed many with oil who were sick
and healed them.
14 King Herod heard this, for his name
had become known, and he said, "John
the Baptizer has risen from the dead, and
therefore these powers are at work in
him."
15 But others said, "He is Elijah." Others
said, "He is a prophet, or like one of the
prophets."
16 But Herod, when he heard this, said,
"This is John, whom I beheaded. He has
risen from the dead."

17 For Herod himself had sent out and
arrested John and bound him in prison
for the sake of Herodias, his brother
Philip's wife, for he had married her.
18 For John had said to Herod, "It is not
lawful for you to have your brother's
wife."
19 Herodias set herself against him and
desired to kill him, but she couldn't,
20 for Herod feared John, knowing that
he was a righteous and holy man, and
kept him safe. When he heard him, he did
many things, and he heard him gladly.
21 Then a convenient day came when
Herod on his birthday made a supper for
his nobles, the high officers, and the chief
men of Galilee.
22 When the daughter of Herodias
herself came in and danced, she pleased
Herod and those sitting with him. The
king said to the young lady, "Ask me
whatever you want, and I will give it to
you."
23 He swore to her, "Whatever you ask
of me, I will give you, up to half of my
kingdom."
24 She went out and said to her mother,
"What shall I ask?"
She said, "The head of John the
Baptizer."
25 She came in immediately with haste
to the king and requested, "I want you to
give me right now the head of John the
Baptizer on a platter."
26 The king was exceedingly sorry, but
for the sake of his oaths and of his dinner
guests, he didn't wish to refuse her.
27 Immediately the king sent out a
soldier of his guard and commanded to
bring John's head; and he went and
beheaded him in the prison,
28 and brought his head on a platter,
and gave it to the young lady; and the
young lady gave it to her mother.
29 When his disciples heard this, they
came and took up his corpse and laid it in
a tomb.
30 The apostles gathered themselves
together to Jesus, and they told him all
things, whatever they had done, and
whatever they had taught.
31 He said to them, "Come away into a
deserted place, and rest awhile." For
there were many coming and going, and
they had no leisure so much as to eat.
32 They went away in the boat to a
deserted place by themselves.
33 They† saw them going, and many
recognized him and ran there on foot
from all the cities. They arrived before
them and came together to him.
34 Jesus came out, saw a great multitude,
and he had compassion on them because
they were like sheep without a shepherd;
and he began to teach them many things.
35 When it was late in the day, his
disciples came to him and said, "This
place is deserted, and it is late in the day.
36 Send them away, that they may go
into the surrounding country and villages
and buy themselves bread, for they have
nothing to eat."
37 But he answered them, "You give
them something to eat."
They asked him, "Shall we go and buy
two hundred denarii‡ worth of bread and
give them something to eat?"
38 He said to them, "How many loaves
do you have? Go see."
When they knew, they said, "Five, and
two fish."
39 He commanded them that everyone
should sit down in groups on the green
grass.
40 They sat down in ranks, by hundreds
and by fifties.
41 He took the five loaves and the two
fish; and looking up to heaven, he blessed
and broke the loaves, and he gave to his
disciples to set before them, and he
divided the two fish among them all.
42 They all ate and were filled.
43 They took up twelve baskets full of
broken pieces and also of the fish.
44 Those who ate the loaves were§ five
thousand men.
45 Immediately he made his disciples get
into the boat and go ahead to the other

† **6:33** TR reads "The multitudes" instead of "They"
‡ **6:37** 200 denarii was about 7 or 8 months wages for an agricultural laborer.
§ **6:44** TR adds "about"

side, to Bethsaida, while he himself sent the multitude away.
46 After he had taken leave of them, he went up the mountain to pray.
47 When evening had come, the boat was in the middle of the sea, and he was alone on the land.
48 Seeing them distressed in rowing, for the wind was contrary to them, about the fourth watch of the night he came to them, walking on the sea;* and he would have passed by them,
49 but they, when they saw him walking on the sea, supposed that it was a ghost, and cried out;
50 for they all saw him and were troubled. But he immediately spoke with them and said to them, "Cheer up! It is I!† Don't be afraid."
51 He got into the boat with them; and the wind ceased, and they were very amazed among themselves, and marveled;
52 for they hadn't understood about the loaves, but their hearts were hardened.
53 When they had crossed over, they came to land at Gennesaret and moored to the shore.
54 When they had come out of the boat, immediately the people recognized him,
55 and ran around that whole region, and began to bring those who were sick on their mats to where they heard he was.
56 Wherever he entered—into villages, or into cities, or into the country—they laid the sick in the marketplaces and begged him that they might just touch the fringe‡ of his garment; and as many as touched him were made well.

7

1 Then the Pharisees and some of the scribes gathered together to him, having come from Jerusalem.
2 Now when they saw some of his disciples eating bread with defiled, that is unwashed, hands, they found fault.
3 (For the Pharisees and all the Jews don't eat unless they wash their hands and forearms, holding to the tradition of the elders.
4 They don't eat when they come from the marketplace unless they bathe themselves, and there are many other things which they have received to hold to: washings of cups, pitchers, bronze vessels, and couches.)
5 The Pharisees and the scribes asked him, "Why don't your disciples walk according to the tradition of the elders, but eat their bread with unwashed hands?"
6 He answered them, "Well did Isaiah prophesy of you hypocrites, as it is written,
'This people honors me with their lips,
but their heart is far from me.
7 They worship me in vain,
teaching as doctrines the
commandments of men.'*
8 "For you set aside the commandment of God, and hold tightly to the tradition of men—the washing of pitchers and cups, and you do many other such things."
9 He said to them, "Full well do you reject the commandment of God, that you may keep your tradition.
10 For Moses said, 'Honor your father and your mother;'* and, 'He who speaks evil of father or mother, let him be put to death.'*
11 But you say, 'If a man tells his father or his mother, "Whatever profit you might have received from me is Corban," ' "† that is to say, given to God,
12 "then you no longer allow him to do anything for his father or his mother,
13 making void the word of God by your tradition which you have handed down. You do many things like this."
14 He called all the multitude to himself and said to them, "Hear me, all of you, and understand.
15 There is nothing from outside of the man that going into him can defile him; but the things which proceed out of the man are those that defile the man.

* **6:48** See Job 9:8 † **6:50** or, "I AM!" ‡ **6:56** or, tassel * **7:7** Isaiah 29:13 * **7:10** Exodus 20:12; Deuteronomy 5:16 * **7:10** Exodus 21:17; Leviticus 20:9 † **7:11** Corban is a Hebrew word for an offering devoted to God. ‡ **7:16** NU omits verse 16.

16 If anyone has ears to hear, let him hear!”‡
17 When he had entered into a house away from the multitude, his disciples asked him about the parable.
18 He said to them, “Are you also without understanding? Don’t you perceive that whatever goes into the man from outside can’t defile him,
19 because it doesn’t go into his heart, but into his stomach, then into the latrine, making all foods clean?”§
20 He said, “That which proceeds out of the man, that defiles the man.
21 For from within, out of the hearts of men, proceed evil thoughts, adulteries, sexual sins, murders, thefts,
22 covetings, wickedness, deceit, lustful desires, an evil eye, blasphemy, pride, and foolishness.
23 All these evil things come from within and defile the man.”
24 From there he arose and went away into the borders of Tyre and Sidon. He entered into a house and didn’t want anyone to know it, but he couldn’t escape notice.
25 For a woman whose little daughter had an unclean spirit, having heard of him, came and fell down at his feet.
26 Now the woman was a Greek, a Syrophoenician by race. She begged him that he would cast the demon out of her daughter.
27 But Jesus said to her, “Let the children be filled first, for it is not appropriate to take the children’s bread and throw it to the dogs.”
28 But she answered him, “Yes, Lord. Yet even the dogs under the table eat the children’s crumbs.”
29 He said to her, “For this saying, go your way. The demon has gone out of your daughter.”
30 She went away to her house, and found the child having been laid on the bed, with the demon gone out.
31 Again he departed from the borders of Tyre and Sidon, and came to the sea of Galilee through the middle of the region of Decapolis.
32 They brought to him one who was deaf and had an impediment in his speech. They begged him to lay his hand on him.
33 He took him aside from the multitude privately and put his fingers into his ears; and he spat and touched his tongue.
34 Looking up to heaven, he sighed, and said to him, “Ephphatha!” that is, “Be opened!”
35 Immediately his ears were opened, and the impediment of his tongue was released, and he spoke clearly.
36 He commanded them that they should tell no one, but the more he commanded them, so much the more widely they proclaimed it.
37 They were astonished beyond measure, saying, “He has done all things well. He makes even the deaf hear and the mute speak!”

8

1 In those days, when there was a very great multitude, and they had nothing to eat, Jesus called his disciples to himself and said to them,
2 “I have compassion on the multitude, because they have stayed with me now three days and have nothing to eat.
3 If I send them away fasting to their home, they will faint on the way, for some of them have come a long way.”
4 His disciples answered him, “From where could one satisfy these people with bread here in a deserted place?”
5 He asked them, “How many loaves do you have?”
They said, “Seven.”
6 He commanded the multitude to sit down on the ground, and he took the seven loaves. Having given thanks, he broke them and gave them to his disciples to serve, and they served the multitude.
7 They also had a few small fish. Having blessed them, he said to serve these also.

§ **7:19** NU ends Jesus’ direct quote and question after “latrine”, ending the verse with “Thus he declared all foods clean.

8 They ate and were filled. They took up
seven baskets of broken pieces that were
left over.
9 Those who had eaten were about four
thousand. Then he sent them away.
10 Immediately he entered into the boat
with his disciples and came into the
region of Dalmanutha.
11 The Pharisees came out and began to
question him, seeking from him a sign
from heaven and testing him.
12 He sighed deeply in his spirit and
said, "Why does this generation† seek a
sign? Most certainly I tell you, no sign will
be given to this generation."
13 He left them, and again entering into
the boat, departed to the other side.
14 They forgot to take bread; and they
didn't have more than one loaf in the boat
with them.
15 He warned them, saying, "Take heed:
beware of the yeast of the Pharisees and
the yeast of Herod."
16 They reasoned with one another,
saying, "It's because we have no bread."
17 Jesus, perceiving it, said to them,
"Why do you reason that it's because you
have no bread? Don't you perceive yet or
understand? Is your heart still hardened?
18 Having eyes, don't you see? Having
ears, don't you hear? Don't you
remember?
19 When I broke the five loaves among
the five thousand, how many baskets full
of broken pieces did you take up?"
They told him, "Twelve."
20 "When the seven loaves fed the four
thousand, how many baskets full of
broken pieces did you take up?"
They told him, "Seven."
21 He asked them, "Don't you
understand yet?"
22 He came to Bethsaida. They brought a
blind man to him and begged him to touch
him.
23 He took hold of the blind man by the
hand, and brought him out of the village.
When he had spat on his eyes, and laid his
hands on him, he asked him if he saw
anything.
24 He looked up, and said, "I see men,
but I see them like walking trees."
25 Then again he laid his hands on his
eyes. He looked intently, and was
restored, and saw everyone clearly.
26 He sent him away to his house,
saying, "Don't enter into the village, nor
tell anyone in the village."
27 Jesus went out, with his disciples, into
the villages of Caesarea Philippi. On the
way he asked his disciples, "Who do men
say that I am?"
28 They told him, "John the Baptizer, and
others say Elijah, but others, one of the
prophets."
29 He said to them, "But who do you say
that I am?"
Peter answered, "You are the Christ."
30 He commanded them that they
should tell no one about him.
31 He began to teach them that the Son
of Man must suffer many things, and be
rejected by the elders, the chief priests,
and the scribes, and be killed, and after
three days rise again.
32 He spoke to them openly. Peter took
him and began to rebuke him.
33 But he, turning around and seeing his
disciples, rebuked Peter, and said, "Get
behind me, Satan! For you have in mind
not the things of God, but the things of
men."
34 He called the multitude to himself
with his disciples and said to them,
"Whoever wants to come after me, let him
deny himself, and take up his cross, and
follow me.
35 For whoever wants to save his life
will lose it; and whoever will lose his life
for my sake and the sake of the Good
News will save it.
36 For what does it profit a man to gain
the whole world and forfeit his life?
37 For what will a man give in exchange
for his life?
38 For whoever will be ashamed of me
and of my words in this adulterous and
sinful generation, the Son of Man also will
be ashamed of him when he comes in his
Father's glory with the holy angels."

† **8:12** The word translated "generation" here (genea) could also be translated "people", "race", or "family".

9

1 He said to them, “Most certainly I tell you, there are some standing here who will in no way taste death until they see God’s Kingdom come with power.”

2 After six days Jesus took with him Peter, James, and John, and brought them up onto a high mountain privately by themselves, and he was changed into another form in front of them.
3 His clothing became glistening, exceedingly white, like snow, such as no launderer on earth can whiten them.
4 Elijah and Moses appeared to them, and they were talking with Jesus.

5 Peter answered Jesus, “Rabbi, it is good for us to be here. Let’s make three tents: one for you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah.”
6 For he didn’t know what to say, for they were very afraid.

7 A cloud came, overshadowing them, and a voice came out of the cloud, “This is my beloved Son. Listen to him.”

8 Suddenly looking around, they saw no one with them any more, except Jesus only.

9 As they were coming down from the mountain, he commanded them that they should tell no one what things they had seen, until after the Son of Man had risen from the dead.
10 They kept this saying to themselves, questioning what the “rising from the dead” meant.
11 They asked him, saying, “Why do the scribes say that Elijah must come first?”

12 He said to them, “Elijah indeed comes first, and restores all things. How is it written about the Son of Man, that he should suffer many things and be despised?
13 But I tell you that Elijah has come, and they have also done to him whatever they wanted to, even as it is written about him.”

14 Coming to the disciples, he saw a great multitude around them, and scribes questioning them.
15 Immediately all the multitude, when they saw him, were greatly amazed, and running to him, greeted him.
16 He asked the scribes, “What are you asking them?”
17 One of the multitude answered, “Teacher, I brought to you my son, who has a mute spirit;
18 and wherever it seizes him, it throws him down; and he foams at the mouth, grinds his teeth, and becomes rigid. I asked your disciples to cast it out, and they weren’t able.”
19 He answered him, “Unbelieving generation, how long shall I be with you? How long shall I bear with you? Bring him to me.”
20 They brought him to him, and when he saw him, immediately the spirit convulsed him and he fell on the ground, wallowing and foaming at the mouth.
21 He asked his father, “How long has it been since this has been happening to him?”
He said, “From childhood.
22 Often it has cast him both into the fire and into the water to destroy him. But if you can do anything, have compassion on us and help us.”
23 Jesus said to him, “If you can believe, all things are possible to him who believes.”
24 Immediately the father of the child cried out with tears, “I believe. Help my unbelief!”
25 When Jesus saw that a multitude came running together, he rebuked the unclean spirit, saying to him, “You mute and deaf spirit, I command you, come out of him, and never enter him again!”
26 After crying out and convulsing him greatly, it came out of him. The boy became like one dead, so much that most of them said, “He is dead.”
27 But Jesus took him by the hand and raised him up; and he arose.
28 When he had come into the house, his disciples asked him privately, “Why couldn’t we cast it out?”
29 He said to them, “This kind can come out by nothing but by prayer and fasting.”

30 They went out from there and passed
through Galilee. He didn't want anyone to
know it,
31 for he was teaching his disciples, and
said to them, "The Son of Man is being
handed over to the hands of men, and
they will kill him; and when he is killed,
on the third day he will rise again."
32 But they didn't understand the
saying, and were afraid to ask him.
33 He came to Capernaum, and when he
was in the house he asked them, "What
were you arguing among yourselves on
the way?"
34 But they were silent, for they had
disputed with one another on the way
about who was the greatest.
35 He sat down and called the twelve;
and he said to them, "If any man wants to
be first, he shall be last of all, and servant
of all."
36 He took a little child and set him in
the middle of them. Taking him in his
arms, he said to them,
37 "Whoever receives one such little
child in my name receives me; and
whoever receives me, doesn't receive me,
but him who sent me."
38 John said to him, "Teacher, we saw
someone who doesn't follow us casting
out demons in your name; and we forbade
him, because he doesn't follow us."
39 But Jesus said, "Don't forbid him, for
there is no one who will do a mighty work
in my name and be able quickly to speak
evil of me.
40 For whoever is not against us is on
our side.
41 For whoever will give you a cup of
water to drink in my name because you
are Christ's, most certainly I tell you, he
will in no way lose his reward.
42 "Whoever will cause one of these
little ones who believe in me to stumble, it
would be better for him if he were thrown
into the sea with a millstone hung around
his neck.
43 If your hand causes you to stumble,
cut it off. It is better for you to enter into
life maimed, rather than having your two
hands to go into Gehenna, † into the
unquenchable fire,
44 'where their worm doesn't die, and
the fire is not quenched.' *‡
45 If your foot causes you to stumble, cut
it off. It is better for you to enter into life
lame, rather than having your two feet to
be cast into Gehenna, § into the fire that
will never be quenched—
46 'where their worm doesn't die, and
the fire is not quenched.' †
47 If your eye causes you to stumble,
throw it out. It is better for you to enter
into God's Kingdom with one eye, rather
than having two eyes to be cast into the
Gehenna‡ of fire,
48 'where their worm doesn't die, and
the fire is not quenched.' *
49 For everyone will be salted with fire,
and every sacrifice will be seasoned with
salt.
50 Salt is good, but if the salt has lost its
saltiness, with what will you season it?
Have salt in yourselves, and be at peace
with one another."

10

1 He arose from there and came into the
borders of Judea and beyond the Jordan.
Multitudes came together to him again. As
he usually did, he was again teaching
them.
2 Pharisees came to him testing him,
and asked him, "Is it lawful for a man to
divorce his wife?"
3 He answered, "What did Moses
command you?"
4 They said, "Moses allowed a certificate
of divorce to be written, and to divorce
her."
5 But Jesus said to them, "For your
hardness of heart, he wrote you this
commandment.
6 But from the beginning of the creation,
God made them male and female.*
7 For this cause a man will leave his
father and mother, and will join to his
wife,
8 and the two will become one flesh,* so
that they are no longer two, but one flesh.

† **9:43** or, Hell * **9:44** Isaiah 66:24 ‡ **9:44** NU omits verse 44. § **9:45** or, Hell † **9:46** NU omits verse 46.
‡ **9:47** or, Hell * **9:48** Isaiah 66:24 * **10:6** Genesis 1:27 * **10:8** Genesis 2:24

9 What therefore God has joined
together, let no man separate."
10 In the house, his disciples asked him
again about the same matter.
11 He said to them, "Whoever divorces
his wife and marries another commits
adultery against her.
12 If a woman herself divorces her
husband and marries another, she
commits adultery."
13 They were bringing to him little
children, that he should touch them, but
the disciples rebuked those who were
bringing them.
14 But when Jesus saw it, he was moved
with indignation and said to them, "Allow
the little children to come to me! Don't
forbid them, for God's Kingdom belongs
to such as these.
15 Most certainly I tell you, whoever will
not receive God's Kingdom like a little
child, he will in no way enter into it."
16 He took them in his arms and blessed
them, laying his hands on them.
17 As he was going out into the way, one
ran to him, knelt before him, and asked
him, "Good Teacher, what shall I do that I
may inherit eternal life?"
18 Jesus said to him, "Why do you call me
good? No one is good except one—God.
19 You know the commandments: 'Do
not murder,' 'Do not commit adultery,' 'Do
not steal,' 'Do not give false testimony,' 'Do
not defraud,' 'Honor your father and
mother.' "*
20 He said to him, "Teacher, I have
observed all these things from my youth."
21 Jesus looking at him loved him, and
said to him, "One thing you lack. Go, sell
whatever you have and give to the poor,
and you will have treasure in heaven; and
come, follow me, taking up the cross."
22 But his face fell at that saying, and he
went away sorrowful, for he was one who
had great possessions.
23 Jesus looked around and said to his
disciples, "How difficult it is for those who
have riches to enter into God's Kingdom!"
24 The disciples were amazed at his
words. But Jesus answered again,
"Children, how hard it is for those who
trust in riches to enter into God's
Kingdom!
25 It is easier for a camel to go through a
needle's eye than for a rich man to enter
into God's Kingdom."
26 They were exceedingly astonished,
saying to him, "Then who can be saved?"
27 Jesus, looking at them, said, "With
men it is impossible, but not with God, for
all things are possible with God."
28 Peter began to tell him, "Behold, we
have left all and have followed you."
29 Jesus said, "Most certainly I tell you,
there is no one who has left house, or
brothers, or sisters, or father, or mother,
or wife, or children, or land, for my sake,
and for the sake of the Good News,
30 but he will receive one hundred times
more now in this time: houses, brothers,
sisters, mothers, children, and land, with
persecutions; and in the age to come
eternal life.
31 But many who are first will be last,
and the last first."
32 They were on the way, going up to
Jerusalem; and Jesus was going in front of
them, and they were amazed; and those
who followed were afraid. He again took
the twelve, and began to tell them the
things that were going to happen to him.
33 "Behold, we are going up to
Jerusalem. The Son of Man will be
delivered to the chief priests and the
scribes. They will condemn him to death,
and will deliver him to the Gentiles.
34 They will mock him, spit on him,
scourge him, and kill him. On the third
day he will rise again."
35 James and John, the sons of Zebedee,
came near to him, saying, "Teacher, we
want you to do for us whatever we will
ask."
36 He said to them, "What do you want
me to do for you?"
37 They said to him, "Grant to us that we
may sit, one at your right hand and one at
your left hand, in your glory."
38 But Jesus said to them, "You don't
know what you are asking. Are you able

* **10:19** Exodus 20:12-16; Deuteronomy 5:16-20

to drink the cup that I drink, and to be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with?"

39 They said to him, "We are able."

Jesus said to them, "You shall indeed drink the cup that I drink, and you shall be baptized with the baptism that I am baptized with;

40 but to sit at my right hand and at my left hand is not mine to give, but for whom it has been prepared."

41 When the ten heard it, they began to be indignant toward James and John.

42 Jesus summoned them and said to them, "You know that they who are recognized as rulers over the nations lord it over them, and their great ones exercise authority over them.

43 But it shall not be so among you, but whoever wants to become great among you shall be your servant.

44 Whoever of you wants to become first among you shall be bondservant of all.

45 For the Son of Man also came not to be served but to serve, and to give his life as a ransom for many."

46 They came to Jericho. As he went out from Jericho with his disciples and a great multitude, the son of Timaeus, Bartimaeus, a blind beggar, was sitting by the road.

47 When he heard that it was Jesus the Nazarene, he began to cry out and say, "Jesus, you son of David, have mercy on me!"

48 Many rebuked him, that he should be quiet, but he cried out much more, "You son of David, have mercy on me!"

49 Jesus stood still and said, "Call him."

They called the blind man, saying to him, "Cheer up! Get up. He is calling you!"

50 He, casting away his cloak, sprang up, and came to Jesus.

51 Jesus asked him, "What do you want me to do for you?"

The blind man said to him, "Rabboni,† that I may see again."

52 Jesus said to him, "Go your way. Your faith has made you well." Immediately he received his sight and followed Jesus on the way.

11

1 When they came near to Jerusalem, to Bethsphage† and Bethany, at the Mount of Olives, he sent two of his disciples

2 and said to them, "Go your way into the village that is opposite you. Immediately as you enter into it, you will find a young donkey tied, on which no one has sat. Untie him and bring him.

3 If anyone asks you, 'Why are you doing this?' say, 'The Lord needs him;' and immediately he will send him back here."

4 They went away, and found a young donkey tied at the door outside in the open street, and they untied him.

5 Some of those who stood there asked them, "What are you doing, untying the young donkey?"

6 They said to them just as Jesus had said, and they let them go.

7 They brought the young donkey to Jesus and threw their garments on it, and Jesus sat on it.

8 Many spread their garments on the way, and others were cutting down branches from the trees and spreading them on the road.

9 Those who went in front and those who followed cried out, "Hosanna!‡ Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord!*

10 Blessed is the kingdom of our father David that is coming in the name of the Lord! Hosanna in the highest!"

11 Jesus entered into the temple in Jerusalem. When he had looked around at everything, it being now evening, he went out to Bethany with the twelve.

12 The next day, when they had come out from Bethany, he was hungry.

13 Seeing a fig tree afar off having leaves, he came to see if perhaps he might find anything on it. When he came to it, he

† **10:51** Rabboni is a transliteration of the Hebrew word for "great teacher." † **11:1** TR & NU read "Bethphage" instead of "Bethsphage" ‡ **11:9** "Hosanna" means "save us" or "help us, we pray". * **11:9** Psalms 118:25-26

found nothing but leaves, for it was not
the season for figs.
14 Jesus told it, "May no one ever eat
fruit from you again!" and his disciples
heard it.
15 They came to Jerusalem, and Jesus
entered into the temple and began to
throw out those who sold and those who
bought in the temple, and overthrew the
money changers' tables and the seats of
those who sold the doves.
16 He would not allow anyone to carry a
container through the temple.
17 He taught, saying to them, "Isn't it
written, 'My house will be called a house
of prayer for all the nations'?* But you
have made it a den of robbers!"*
18 The chief priests and the scribes
heard it, and sought how they might
destroy him. For they feared him, because
all the multitude was astonished at his
teaching.
19 When evening came, he went out of
the city.
20 As they passed by in the morning,
they saw the fig tree withered away from
the roots.
21 Peter, remembering, said to him,
"Rabbi, look! The fig tree which you
cursed has withered away."
22 Jesus answered them, "Have faith in
God.
23 For most certainly I tell you, whoever
may tell this mountain, 'Be taken up and
cast into the sea,' and doesn't doubt in his
heart, but believes that what he says is
happening, he shall have whatever he
says.
24 Therefore I tell you, all things
whatever you pray and ask for, believe
that you have received them, and you
shall have them.
25 Whenever you stand praying, forgive,
if you have anything against anyone; so
that your Father, who is in heaven, may
also forgive you your transgressions.
26 But if you do not forgive, neither will
your Father in heaven forgive your
transgressions."§
27 They came again to Jerusalem, and as
he was walking in the temple, the chief
priests, the scribes, and the elders came to
him,
28 and they began saying to him, "By
what authority do you do these things? Or
who gave you this authority to do these
things?"
29 Jesus said to them, "I will ask you one
question. Answer me, and I will tell you
by what authority I do these things.
30 The baptism of John—was it from
heaven, or from men? Answer me."
31 They reasoned with themselves,
saying, "If we should say, 'From heaven;'
he will say, 'Why then did you not believe
him?'
32 If we should say, 'From men' "—they
feared the people, for all held John to
really be a prophet.
33 They answered Jesus, "We don't
know."
Jesus said to them, "Neither will I tell
you by what authority I do these things."

12

1 He began to speak to them in parables.
"A man planted a vineyard, put a hedge
around it, dug a pit for the wine press,
built a tower, rented it out to a farmer,
and went into another country.
2 When it was time, he sent a servant to
the farmer to get from the farmer his
share of the fruit of the vineyard.
3 They took him, beat him, and sent him
away empty.
4 Again, he sent another servant to
them; and they threw stones at him,
wounded him in the head, and sent him
away shamefully treated.
5 Again he sent another, and they killed
him, and many others, beating some, and
killing some.
6 Therefore still having one, his beloved
son, he sent him last to them, saying, 'They
will respect my son.'
7 But those farmers said among
themselves, 'This is the heir. Come, let's
kill him, and the inheritance will be ours.'

* **11:17** Isaiah 56:7 * **11:17** Jeremiah 7:11 § **11:26** NU omits verse 26.

8 They took him, killed him, and cast
him out of the vineyard.
9 What therefore will the lord of the
vineyard do? He will come and destroy
the farmers, and will give the vineyard to
others.
10 Haven't you even read this Scripture:
'The stone which the builders rejected
was made the head of the corner.
11 This was from the Lord.
It is marvelous in our eyes'?"*
12 They tried to seize him, but they
feared the multitude; for they perceived
that he spoke the parable against them.
They left him and went away.
13 They sent some of the Pharisees and
the Herodians to him, that they might trap
him with words.
14 When they had come, they asked him,
"Teacher, we know that you are honest,
and don't defer to anyone; for you aren't
partial to anyone, but truly teach the way
of God. Is it lawful to pay taxes to Caesar,
or not?
15 Shall we give, or shall we not give?"
But he, knowing their hypocrisy, said to
them, "Why do you test me? Bring me a
denarius, that I may see it."
16 They brought it.
He said to them, "Whose is this image
and inscription?"
They said to him, "Caesar's."
17 Jesus answered them, "Give to Caesar
the things that are Caesar's, and to God
the things that are God's."
They marveled greatly at him.
18 Some Sadducees, who say that there
is no resurrection, came to him. They
asked him, saying,
19 "Teacher, Moses wrote to us, 'If a
man's brother dies and leaves a wife
behind him, and leaves no children, that
his brother should take his wife and raise
up offspring for his brother.'
20 There were seven brothers. The first
took a wife, and dying left no offspring.
21 The second took her, and died,
leaving no children behind him. The third
likewise;
22 and the seven took her and left no
children. Last of all the woman also died.
23 In the resurrection, when they rise,
whose wife will she be of them? For the
seven had her as a wife."
24 Jesus answered them, "Isn't this
because you are mistaken, not knowing
the Scriptures nor the power of God?
25 For when they will rise from the dead,
they neither marry nor are given in
marriage, but are like angels in heaven.
26 But about the dead, that they are
raised, haven't you read in the book of
Moses about the Bush, how God spoke to
him, saying, 'I am the God of Abraham, the
God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob'?*
27 He is not the God of the dead, but of
the living. You are therefore badly
mistaken."
28 One of the scribes came and heard
them questioning together, and knowing
that he had answered them well, asked
him, "Which commandment is the
greatest of all?"
29 Jesus answered, "The greatest is:
'Hear, Israel, the Lord our God, the Lord is
one.
30 You shall love the Lord your God with
all your heart, with all your soul, with all
your mind, and with all your strength.'*
This is the first commandment.
31 The second is like this: 'You shall love
your neighbor as yourself.'* There is no
other commandment greater than these."
32 The scribe said to him, "Truly,
teacher, you have said well that he is one,
and there is none other but he;
33 and to love him with all the heart,
with all the understanding, all the soul,
and with all the strength, and to love his
neighbor as himself, is more important
than all whole burnt offerings and
sacrifices."
34 When Jesus saw that he answered
wisely, he said to him, "You are not far
from God's Kingdom."
No one dared ask him any question
after that.

* **12:11** Psalms 118:22-23 * **12:26** Exodus 3:6 * **12:30** Deuteronomy 6:4-5 * **12:31** Leviticus 19:18

35 Jesus responded, as he taught in the
temple, "How is it that the scribes say that
the Christ is the son of David?
36 For David himself said in the Holy
Spirit,
'The Lord said to my Lord,
"Sit at my right hand,
until I make your enemies the
footstool of your feet." '*
37 Therefore David himself calls him
Lord, so how can he be his son?"
The common people heard him gladly.
38 In his teaching he said to them,
"Beware of the scribes, who like to walk in
long robes, and to get greetings in the
marketplaces,
39 and to get the best seats in the
synagogues and the best places at feasts,
40 those who devour widows' houses,
and for a pretense make long prayers.
These will receive greater
condemnation."
41 Jesus sat down opposite the treasury
and saw how the multitude cast money
into the treasury. Many who were rich
cast in much.
42 A poor widow came and she cast in
two small brass coins,† which equal a
quadrans coin.‡
43 He called his disciples to himself and
said to them, "Most certainly I tell you,
this poor widow gave more than all those
who are giving into the treasury,
44 for they all gave out of their
abundance, but she, out of her poverty,
gave all that she had to live on."

13

1 As he went out of the temple, one of his
disciples said to him, "Teacher, see what
kind of stones and what kind of
buildings!"
2 Jesus said to him, "Do you see these
great buildings? There will not be left
here one stone on another, which will not
be thrown down."
3 As he sat on the Mount of Olives
opposite the temple, Peter, James, John,
and Andrew asked him privately,
4 "Tell us, when will these things be?
What is the sign that these things are all
about to be fulfilled?"
5 Jesus, answering, began to tell them,
"Be careful that no one leads you astray.
6 For many will come in my name,
saying, 'I am he!'† and will lead many
astray.
7 "When you hear of wars and rumors
of wars, don't be troubled. For those must
happen, but the end is not yet.
8 For nation will rise against nation, and
kingdom against kingdom. There will be
earthquakes in various places. There will
be famines and troubles. These things are
the beginning of birth pains.
9 "But watch yourselves, for they will
deliver you up to councils. You will be
beaten in synagogues. You will stand
before rulers and kings for my sake, for a
testimony to them.
10 The Good News must first be
preached to all the nations.
11 When they lead you away and deliver
you up, don't be anxious beforehand or
premeditate what you will say, but say
whatever will be given you in that hour.
For it is not you who speak, but the Holy
Spirit.
12 "Brother will deliver up brother to
death, and the father his child. Children
will rise up against parents and cause
them to be put to death.
13 You will be hated by all men for my
name's sake, but he who endures to the
end will be saved.
14 "But when you see the abomination
of desolation,* spoken of by Daniel the
prophet, standing where it ought not" (let
the reader understand), "then let those
who are in Judea flee to the mountains,
15 and let him who is on the housetop
not go down, nor enter in, to take
anything out of his house.

* **12:36** Psalms 110:1 † **12:42** literally, lepta (or widow's mites). Lepta are very small brass coins worth half a quadrans each, which is a quarter of the copper assarion. Lepta are worth less than 1% of an agricultural worker's daily wages. ‡ **12:42** A quadrans is a coin worth about 1/64 of a denarius. A denarius is about one day's wages for an agricultural laborer. † **13:6** or, "I AM!" * **13:14** Daniel 9:17; 11:31; 12:11

16 Let him who is in the field not return back to take his cloak.
17 But woe to those who are with child and to those who nurse babies in those days!
18 Pray that your flight won't be in the winter.
19 For in those days there will be oppression, such as there has not been the like from the beginning of the creation which God created until now, and never will be.
20 Unless the Lord had shortened the days, no flesh would have been saved; but for the sake of the chosen ones, whom he picked out, he shortened the days.
21 Then if anyone tells you, 'Look, here is the Christ!' or, 'Look, there!' don't believe it.
22 For false christs and false prophets will arise and will show signs and wonders, that they may lead astray, if possible, even the chosen ones.
23 But you watch.

"Behold, I have told you all things beforehand.
24 But in those days, after that oppression, the sun will be darkened, the moon will not give its light,
25 the stars will be falling from the sky, and the powers that are in the heavens will be shaken.*
26 Then they will see the Son of Man coming in clouds with great power and glory.
27 Then he will send out his angels, and will gather together his chosen ones from the four winds, from the ends of the earth to the ends of the sky.

28 "Now from the fig tree, learn this parable. When the branch has now become tender and produces its leaves, you know that the summer is near;
29 even so you also, when you see these things coming to pass, know that it is near, at the doors.
30 Most certainly I say to you, this generation‡ will not pass away until all these things happen.
31 Heaven and earth will pass away, but my words will not pass away.
32 "But of that day or that hour no one knows—not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father.
33 Watch, keep alert, and pray; for you don't know when the time is.
34 "It is like a man traveling to another country, having left his house and given authority to his servants, and to each one his work, and also commanded the doorkeeper to keep watch.
35 Watch therefore, for you don't know when the lord of the house is coming—whether at evening, or at midnight, or when the rooster crows, or in the morning;
36 lest, coming suddenly, he might find you sleeping.
37 What I tell you, I tell all: Watch!"

14

1 It was now two days before the Passover and the Feast of Unleavened Bread, and the chief priests and the scribes sought how they might seize him by deception and kill him.
2 For they said, "Not during the feast, because there might be a riot among the people."
3 While he was at Bethany, in the house of Simon the leper, as he sat at the table, a woman came having an alabaster jar of ointment of pure nard—very costly. She broke the jar and poured it over his head.
4 But there were some who were indignant among themselves, saying, "Why has this ointment been wasted?
5 For this might have been sold for more than three hundred denarii† and given to the poor." So they grumbled against her.
6 But Jesus said, "Leave her alone. Why do you trouble her? She has done a good work for me.
7 For you always have the poor with you, and whenever you want to, you can do them good; but you will not always have me.

* **13:25** Isaiah 13:10; 34:4 ‡ **13:30** The word translated "generation" (genea) could also be translated "race", "family", or "people". † **14:5** 300 denarii was about a year's wages for an agricultural laborer.

8 She has done what she could. She has
anointed my body beforehand for the
burying.
9 Most certainly I tell you, wherever this
Good News may be preached throughout
the whole world, that which this woman
has done will also be spoken of for a
memorial of her."
10 Judas Iscariot, who was one of the
twelve, went away to the chief priests,
that he might deliver him to them.
11 They, when they heard it, were glad,
and promised to give him money. He
sought how he might conveniently deliver
him.
12 On the first day of unleavened bread,
when they sacrificed the Passover, his
disciples asked him, "Where do you want
us to go and prepare that you may eat the
Passover?"
13 He sent two of his disciples and said
to them, "Go into the city, and there a man
carrying a pitcher of water will meet you.
Follow him,
14 and wherever he enters in, tell the
master of the house, 'The Teacher says,
"Where is the guest room, where I may eat
the Passover with my disciples?" '
15 He will himself show you a large
upper room furnished and ready. Get
ready for us there."
16 His disciples went out, and came into
the city, and found things as he had said to
them, and they prepared the Passover.
17 When it was evening he came with
the twelve.
18 As they sat and were eating, Jesus
said, "Most certainly I tell you, one of you
will betray me—he who eats with me."
19 They began to be sorrowful, and to
ask him one by one, "Surely not I?" And
another said, "Surely not I?"
20 He answered them, "It is one of the
twelve, he who dips with me in the dish.
21 For the Son of Man goes as it is
written about him, but woe to that man by
whom the Son of Man is betrayed! It
would be better for that man if he had not
been born."
22 As they were eating, Jesus took bread,
and when he had blessed it, he broke it
and gave to them, and said, "Take, eat.
This is my body."
23 He took the cup, and when he had
given thanks, he gave to them. They all
drank of it.
24 He said to them, "This is my blood of
the new covenant, which is poured out for
many.
25 Most certainly I tell you, I will no
more drink of the fruit of the vine until
that day when I drink it anew in God's
Kingdom."
26 When they had sung a hymn, they
went out to the Mount of Olives.
27 Jesus said to them, "All of you will be
made to stumble because of me tonight,
for it is written, 'I will strike the shepherd,
and the sheep will be scattered.'*
28 However, after I am raised up, I will
go before you into Galilee."
29 But Peter said to him, "Although all
will be offended, yet I will not."
30 Jesus said to him, "Most certainly I tell
you that you today, even this night, before
the rooster crows twice, you will deny me
three times."
31 But he spoke all the more, "If I must
die with you, I will not deny you." They all
said the same thing.
32 They came to a place which was
named Gethsemane. He said to his
disciples, "Sit here while I pray."
33 He took with him Peter, James, and
John, and began to be greatly troubled
and distressed.
34 He said to them, "My soul is
exceedingly sorrowful, even to death.
Stay here and watch."
35 He went forward a little, and fell on
the ground, and prayed that if it were
possible, the hour might pass away from
him.
36 He said, "Abba,‡ Father, all things are
possible to you. Please remove this cup
from me. However, not what I desire, but
what you desire."

* **14:27** Zechariah 13:7 ‡ **14:36** Abba is a Greek spelling for the Aramaic word for "Father" or "Daddy" used in a familiar, respectful, and loving way.

37 He came and found them sleeping,
and said to Peter, "Simon, are you
sleeping? Couldn't you watch one hour?
38 Watch and pray, that you may not
enter into temptation. The spirit indeed is
willing, but the flesh is weak."
39 Again he went away and prayed,
saying the same words.
40 Again he returned and found them
sleeping, for their eyes were very heavy;
and they didn't know what to answer him.
41 He came the third time and said to
them, "Sleep on now, and take your rest. It
is enough. The hour has come. Behold, the
Son of Man is betrayed into the hands of
sinners.
42 Arise! Let's get going. Behold, he who
betrays me is at hand."
43 Immediately, while he was still
speaking, Judas, one of the twelve,
came—and with him a multitude with
swords and clubs, from the chief priests,
the scribes, and the elders.
44 Now he who betrayed him had given
them a sign, saying, "Whomever I will
kiss, that is he. Seize him, and lead him
away safely."
45 When he had come, immediately he
came to him and said, "Rabbi! Rabbi!"
and kissed him.
46 They laid their hands on him and
seized him.
47 But a certain one of those who stood
by drew his sword and struck the servant
of the high priest, and cut off his ear.
48 Jesus answered them, "Have you
come out, as against a robber, with
swords and clubs to seize me?
49 I was daily with you in the temple
teaching, and you didn't arrest me. But
this is so that the Scriptures might be
fulfilled."
50 They all left him, and fled.
51 A certain young man followed him,
having a linen cloth thrown around
himself over his naked body. The young
men grabbed him,
52 but he left the linen cloth and fled
from them naked.
53 They led Jesus away to the high priest.
All the chief priests, the elders, and the
scribes came together with him.
54 Peter had followed him from a
distance, until he came into the court of
the high priest. He was sitting with the
officers, and warming himself in the light
of the fire.
55 Now the chief priests and the whole
council sought witnesses against Jesus to
put him to death, and found none.
56 For many gave false testimony
against him, and their testimony didn't
agree with each other.
57 Some stood up and gave false
testimony against him, saying,
58 "We heard him say, 'I will destroy this
temple that is made with hands, and in
three days I will build another made
without hands.' "
59 Even so, their testimony didn't agree.
60 The high priest stood up in the
middle, and asked Jesus, "Have you no
answer? What is it which these testify
against you?"
61 But he stayed quiet, and answered
nothing. Again the high priest asked him,
"Are you the Christ, the Son of the
Blessed?"
62 Jesus said, "I am. You will see the Son
of Man sitting at the right hand of Power,
and coming with the clouds of the sky."
63 The high priest tore his clothes and
said, "What further need have we of
witnesses?
64 You have heard the blasphemy! What
do you think?" They all condemned him
to be worthy of death.
65 Some began to spit on him, and to
cover his face, and to beat him with fists,
and to tell him, "Prophesy!" The officers
struck him with the palms of their hands.
66 As Peter was in the courtyard below,
one of the maids of the high priest came,
67 and seeing Peter warming himself,
she looked at him and said, "You were also
with the Nazarene, Jesus!"
68 But he denied it, saying, "I neither
know nor understand what you are
saying." He went out on the porch, and
the rooster crowed.
69 The maid saw him and began again to
tell those who stood by, "This is one of
them."

70 But he again denied it. After a little
while again those who stood by said to
Peter, “You truly are one of them, for you
are a Galilean, and your speech shows it.”
71 But he began to curse and to swear, “I
don’t know this man of whom you speak!”
72 The rooster crowed the second time.
Peter remembered the words that Jesus
said to him, “Before the rooster crows
twice, you will deny me three times.”
When he thought about that, he wept.

15

1 Immediately in the morning the chief
priests, with the elders, scribes, and the
whole council, held a consultation, bound
Jesus, carried him away, and delivered
him up to Pilate.
2 Pilate asked him, “Are you the King of
the Jews?”
He answered, “So you say.”
3 The chief priests accused him of many
things.
4 Pilate again asked him, “Have you no
answer? See how many things they testify
against you!”
5 But Jesus made no further answer, so
that Pilate marveled.
6 Now at the feast he used to release to
them one prisoner, whomever they asked
of him.
7 There was one called Barabbas, bound
with his fellow insurgents, men who in
the insurrection had committed murder.
8 The multitude, crying aloud, began to
ask him to do as he always did for them.
9 Pilate answered them, saying, “Do you
want me to release to you the King of the
Jews?”
10 For he perceived that for envy the
chief priests had delivered him up.
11 But the chief priests stirred up the
multitude, that he should release
Barabbas to them instead.
12 Pilate again asked them, “What then
should I do to him whom you call the King
of the Jews?”
13 They cried out again, “Crucify him!”
14 Pilate said to them, “Why, what evil
has he done?”
But they cried out exceedingly, “Crucify
him!”
15 Pilate, wishing to please the
multitude, released Barabbas to them,
and handed over Jesus, when he had
flogged him, to be crucified.
16 The soldiers led him away within the
court, which is the Praetorium; and they
called together the whole cohort.
17 They clothed him with purple; and
weaving a crown of thorns, they put it on
him.
18 They began to salute him, “Hail, King
of the Jews!”
19 They struck his head with a reed and
spat on him, and bowing their knees, did
homage to him.
20 When they had mocked him, they
took the purple cloak off him, and put his
own garments on him. They led him out
to crucify him.
21 They compelled one passing by,
coming from the country, Simon of
Cyrene, the father of Alexander and
Rufus, to go with them that he might bear
his cross.
22 They brought him to the place called
Golgotha, which is, being interpreted,
“The place of a skull.”
23 They offered him wine mixed with
myrrh to drink, but he didn’t take it.
24 Crucifying him, they parted his
garments among them, casting lots on
them, what each should take.
25 It was the third hour† when they
crucified him.
26 The superscription of his accusation
was written over him: “THE KING OF THE
JEWS.”
27 With him they crucified two robbers,
one on his right hand, and one on his left.
28 The Scripture was fulfilled which
says, “He was counted with
transgressors.”‡
29 Those who passed by blasphemed
him, wagging their heads and saying, “Ha!
You who destroy the temple and build it in
three days,
30 save yourself, and come down from
the cross!”

† **15:25** 9:00 a.m. ‡ **15:28** NU omits verse 28.

31 Likewise, also the chief priests
mocking among themselves with the
scribes said, “He saved others. He can’t
save himself.
32 Let the Christ, the King of Israel, now
come down from the cross, that we may
see and believe him.”§ Those who were
crucified with him also insulted him.
33 When the sixth hour† had come, there
was darkness over the whole land until
the ninth hour.‡
34 At the ninth hour Jesus cried with a
loud voice, saying, “Eloi, Eloi, lama
sabachthani?” which is, being
interpreted, “My God, my God, why have
you forsaken me?” *
35 Some of those who stood by, when
they heard it, said, “Behold, he is calling
Elijah.”
36 One ran, and filling a sponge full of
vinegar, put it on a reed and gave it to him
to drink, saying, “Let him be. Let’s see
whether Elijah comes to take him down.”
37 Jesus cried out with a loud voice, and
gave up the spirit.
38 The veil of the temple was torn in two
from the top to the bottom.
39 When the centurion, who stood by
opposite him, saw that he cried out like
this and breathed his last, he said, “Truly
this man was the Son of God!”
40 There were also women watching
from afar, among whom were both Mary
Magdalene and Mary the mother of James
the less and of Joses, and Salome;
41 who, when he was in Galilee,
followed him and served him; and many
other women who came up with him to
Jerusalem.
42 When evening had now come,
because it was the Preparation Day, that
is, the day before the Sabbath,
43 Joseph of Arimathaea, a prominent
council member who also himself was
looking for God’s Kingdom, came. He
boldly went in to Pilate, and asked for
Jesus’ body.
44 Pilate was surprised to hear that he
was already dead; and summoning the
centurion, he asked him whether he had
been dead long.
45 When he found out from the
centurion, he granted the body to Joseph.
46 He bought a linen cloth, and taking
him down, wound him in the linen cloth
and laid him in a tomb which had been
cut out of a rock. He rolled a stone against
the door of the tomb.
47 Mary Magdalene and Mary the
mother of Joses, saw where he was laid.

16

1 When the Sabbath was past, Mary
Magdalene, and Mary the mother of
James, and Salome bought spices, that
they might come and anoint him.
2 Very early on the first day of the week,
they came to the tomb when the sun had
risen.
3 They were saying among themselves,
“Who will roll away the stone from the
door of the tomb for us?”
4 for it was very big. Looking up, they
saw that the stone was rolled back.
5 Entering into the tomb, they saw a
young man sitting on the right side,
dressed in a white robe; and they were
amazed.
6 He said to them, “Don’t be amazed.
You seek Jesus, the Nazarene, who has
been crucified. He has risen! He is not
here. See the place where they laid him!
7 But go, tell his disciples and Peter, ‘He
goes before you into Galilee. There you
will see him, as he said to you.’ ”
8 They went out,† and fled from the
tomb, for trembling and astonishment
had come on them. They said nothing to
anyone; for they were afraid.‡

§ **15:32** TR omits “him” † **15:33** or, noon ‡ **15:33** 3:00 p.m. * **15:34** Psalms 22:1 † **16:8** TR adds “quickly” ‡ **16:8** One isolated manuscript omits verses 9-20 but adds this “short ending of Mark” to the end of verse 8: *They told all that had been commanded them briefly to those around Peter. After that, Jesus himself sent them out, from east to west, with the sacred and imperishable proclamation of eternal salvation.* § **16:9** NU includes the text of verses 9-20, but mentions in a footnote that a few manuscripts omitted it. The translators of the World English Bible regard Mark 16:9-20 as reliable based on an overwhelming majority of textual evidence, including not only the authoritative Greek Majority Text New Testament, but also the TR and many of the manuscripts cited in the NU text.

9 §Now when he had risen early on the
first day of the week, he appeared first to
Mary Magdalene, from whom he had cast
out seven demons.
10 She went and told those who had
been with him, as they mourned and
wept.
11 When they heard that he was alive
and had been seen by her, they
disbelieved.
12 After these things he was revealed in
another form to two of them as they
walked, on their way into the country.
13 They went away and told it to the rest.
They didn't believe them, either.
14 Afterward he was revealed to the
eleven themselves as they sat at the table;
and he rebuked them for their unbelief
and hardness of heart, because they
didn't believe those who had seen him
after he had risen.
15 He said to them, "Go into all the world
and preach the Good News to the whole
creation.
16 He who believes and is baptized will
be saved; but he who disbelieves will be
condemned.
17 These signs will accompany those
who believe: in my name they will cast
out demons; they will speak with new
languages;
18 they will take up serpents; and if they
drink any deadly thing, it will in no way
hurt them; they will lay hands on the sick,
and they will recover."
19 So then the Lord,† after he had spoken
to them, was received up into heaven and
sat down at the right hand of God.
20 They went out and preached
everywhere, the Lord working with them
and confirming the word by the signs that
followed. Amen.

† **16:19** NU adds "Jesus"

The Good News According to Luke

1 Since many have undertaken to set in
order a narrative concerning those
matters which have been fulfilled among
us,
2 even as those who from the beginning
were eyewitnesses and servants of the
word delivered them to us,
3 it seemed good to me also, having
traced the course of all things accurately
from the first, to write to you in order,
most excellent Theophilus;
4 that you might know the certainty
concerning the things in which you were
instructed.
5 There was in the days of Herod, the
king of Judea, a certain priest named
Zacharias, of the priestly division of
Abijah. He had a wife of the daughters of
Aaron, and her name was Elizabeth.
6 They were both righteous before God,
walking blamelessly in all the
commandments and ordinances of the
Lord.
7 But they had no child, because
Elizabeth was barren, and they both were
well advanced in years.
8 Now while he executed the priest's
office before God in the order of his
division
9 according to the custom of the priest's
office, his lot was to enter into the temple
of the Lord and burn incense.
10 The whole multitude of the people
were praying outside at the hour of
incense.
11 An angel of the Lord appeared to him,
standing on the right side of the altar of
incense.
12 Zacharias was troubled when he saw
him, and fear fell upon him.
13 But the angel said to him, "Don't be
afraid, Zacharias, because your request
has been heard. Your wife, Elizabeth, will
bear you a son, and you shall call his
name John.
14 You will have joy and gladness, and
many will rejoice at his birth.
15 For he will be great in the sight of the
Lord, and he will drink no wine nor
strong drink. He will be filled with the
Holy Spirit, even from his mother's womb.
16 He will turn many of the children of
Israel to the Lord their God.
17 He will go before him in the spirit and
power of Elijah, 'to turn the hearts of the
fathers to the children,'* and the
disobedient to the wisdom of the just; to
prepare a people prepared for the Lord."
18 Zacharias said to the angel, "How can
I be sure of this? For I am an old man, and
my wife is well advanced in years."
19 The angel answered him, "I am
Gabriel, who stands in the presence of
God. I was sent to speak to you and to
bring you this good news.
20 Behold,† you will be silent and not
able to speak until the day that these
things will happen, because you didn't
believe my words, which will be fulfilled
in their proper time."
21 The people were waiting for
Zacharias, and they marveled that he
delayed in the temple.
22 When he came out, he could not
speak to them. They perceived that he had
seen a vision in the temple. He continued
making signs to them, and remained
mute.
23 When the days of his service were
fulfilled, he departed to his house.
24 After these days Elizabeth his wife
conceived, and she hid herself five
months, saying,
25 "Thus has the Lord done to me in the
days in which he looked at me, to take
away my reproach among men."
26 Now in the sixth month, the angel
Gabriel was sent from God to a city of
Galilee named Nazareth,
27 to a virgin pledged to be married to a
man whose name was Joseph, of David's
house. The virgin's name was Mary.
28 Having come in, the angel said to her,
"Rejoice, you highly favored one! The

* **1:17** Malachi 4:6 † **1:20** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

Lord is with you. Blessed are you among
women!”
29 But when she saw him, she was
greatly troubled at the saying, and
considered what kind of salutation this
might be.
30 The angel said to her, “Don’t be afraid,
Mary, for you have found favor with God.
31 Behold, you will conceive in your
womb and give birth to a son, and shall
name him ‘Jesus.’
32 He will be great and will be called the
Son of the Most High. The Lord God will
give him the throne of his father David,
33 and he will reign over the house of
Jacob forever. There will be no end to his
Kingdom.”
34 Mary said to the angel, “How can this
be, seeing I am a virgin?”
35 The angel answered her, “The Holy
Spirit will come on you, and the power of
the Most High will overshadow you.
Therefore also the holy one who is born
from you will be called the Son of God.
36 Behold, Elizabeth your relative also
has conceived a son in her old age; and
this is the sixth month with her who was
called barren.
37 For nothing spoken by God is
impossible.”‡
38 Mary said, “Behold, the servant of the
Lord; let it be done to me according to
your word.”

Then the angel departed from her.

39 Mary arose in those days and went
into the hill country with haste, into a city
of Judah,
40 and entered into the house of
Zacharias and greeted Elizabeth.
41 When Elizabeth heard Mary’s
greeting, the baby leaped in her womb;
and Elizabeth was filled with the Holy
Spirit.
42 She called out with a loud voice and
said, “Blessed are you among women, and
blessed is the fruit of your womb!
43 Why am I so favored, that the mother
of my Lord should come to me?
44 For behold, when the voice of your
greeting came into my ears, the baby
leaped in my womb for joy!
45 Blessed is she who believed, for there
will be a fulfillment of the things which
have been spoken to her from the Lord!”
46 Mary said,
“My soul magnifies the Lord.
47 My spirit has rejoiced in God my
Savior,
48 for he has looked at the humble
state of his servant.
For behold, from now on, all generations
will call me blessed.
49 For he who is mighty has done
great things for me.
Holy is his name.
50 His mercy is for generations and
generations on those who fear him.
51 He has shown strength with his arm.
He has scattered the proud in the
imagination of their hearts.
52 He has put down princes from their
thrones,
and has exalted the lowly.
53 He has filled the hungry with good
things.
He has sent the rich away empty.
54 He has given help to Israel, his servant,
that he might remember mercy,
55 as he spoke to our fathers,
to Abraham and his offspring§
forever.”
56 Mary stayed with her about three
months, and then returned to her house.
57 Now the time that Elizabeth should
give birth was fulfilled, and she gave birth
to a son.
58 Her neighbors and her relatives
heard that the Lord had magnified his
mercy toward her, and they rejoiced with
her.
59 On the eighth day, they came to
circumcise the child; and they would have
called him Zacharias, after the name of
his father.
60 His mother answered, “Not so; but he
will be called John.”
61 They said to her, “There is no one
among your relatives who is called by this
name.”

‡ **1:37** or, “For everything spoken by God is possible.”

§ **1:55** or, seed

62 They made signs to his father, what
he would have him called.
63 He asked for a writing tablet, and
wrote, “His name is John.”
They all marveled.
64 His mouth was opened immediately
and his tongue freed, and he spoke,
blessing God.
65 Fear came on all who lived around
them, and all these sayings were talked
about throughout all the hill country of
Judea.
66 All who heard them laid them up in
their heart, saying, “What then will this
child be?” The hand of the Lord was with
him.
67 His father Zacharias was filled with
the Holy Spirit, and prophesied, saying,
68 “Blessed be the Lord, the God of Israel,
for he has visited and redeemed his
people;
69 and has raised up a horn of salvation for
us in the house of his servant David
70 (as he spoke by the mouth of his
holy prophets who have been from
of old),
71 salvation from our enemies and
from the hand of all who hate us;
72 to show mercy toward our fathers,
to remember his holy covenant,
73 the oath which he swore to Abraham
our father,
74 to grant to us that we, being
delivered out of the hand of our
enemies,
should serve him without fear,
75 in holiness and righteousness
before him all the days of our life.
76 And you, child, will be called a prophet
of the Most High;
for you will go before the face of the
Lord to prepare his ways,
77 to give knowledge of salvation to
his people by the remission of their
sins,
78 because of the tender mercy of our God,
by which the dawn from on high will
visit us,
79 to shine on those who sit in
darkness and the shadow of death;
to guide our feet into the way of
peace.”
80 The child was growing and becoming
strong in spirit, and was in the desert until
the day of his public appearance to Israel.

2

1 Now in those days, a decree went out
from Caesar Augustus that all the world
should be enrolled.
2 This was the first enrollment made
when Quirinius was governor of Syria.
3 All went to enroll themselves,
everyone to his own city.
4 Joseph also went up from Galilee, out
of the city of Nazareth, into Judea, to
David’s city, which is called Bethlehem,
because he was of the house and family of
David,
5 to enroll himself with Mary, who was
pledged to be married to him as wife,
being pregnant.
6 While they were there, the day had
come for her to give birth.
7 She gave birth to her firstborn son.
She wrapped him in bands of cloth and
laid him in a feeding trough, because
there was no room for them in the inn.
8 There were shepherds in the same
country staying in the field, and keeping
watch by night over their flock.
9 Behold, an angel of the Lord stood by
them, and the glory of the Lord shone
around them, and they were terrified.
10 The angel said to them, “Don’t be
afraid, for behold, I bring you good news
of great joy which will be to all the people.
11 For there is born to you today, in
David’s city, a Savior, who is Christ† the
Lord.
12 This is the sign to you: you will find a
baby wrapped in strips of cloth, lying in a
feeding trough.”
13 Suddenly, there was with the angel a
multitude of the heavenly army praising
God and saying,
14 “Glory to God in the highest,
on earth peace, good will toward
men.”

† **2:11** “Christ” means “Anointed One”.

15 When the angels went away from
them into the sky, the shepherds said to
one another, “Let’s go to Bethlehem, now,
and see this thing that has happened,
which the Lord has made known to us.”
16 They came with haste and found both
Mary and Joseph, and the baby was lying
in the feeding trough.
17 When they saw it, they publicized
widely the saying which was spoken to
them about this child.
18 All who heard it wondered at the
things which were spoken to them by the
shepherds.
19 But Mary kept all these sayings,
pondering them in her heart.
20 The shepherds returned, glorifying
and praising God for all the things that
they had heard and seen, just as it was
told them.
21 When eight days were fulfilled for the
circumcision of the child, his name was
called Jesus, which was given by the angel
before he was conceived in the womb.
22 When the days of their purification
according to the law of Moses were
fulfilled, they brought him up to
Jerusalem to present him to the Lord
23 (as it is written in the law of the Lord,
“Every male who opens the womb shall be
called holy to the Lord”),*
24 and to offer a sacrifice according to
that which is said in the law of the Lord,
“A pair of turtledoves, or two young
pigeons.”*
25 Behold, there was a man in Jerusalem
whose name was Simeon. This man was
righteous and devout, looking for the
consolation of Israel, and the Holy Spirit
was on him.
26 It had been revealed to him by the
Holy Spirit that he should not see death
before he had seen the Lord’s Christ.‡
27 He came in the Spirit into the temple.
When the parents brought in the child,
Jesus, that they might do concerning him
according to the custom of the law,
28 then he received him into his arms
and blessed God, and said,
29 “Now you are releasing your servant,
Master,
according to your word, in peace;
30 for my eyes have seen your salvation,
31 which you have prepared before
the face of all peoples;
32 a light for revelation to the nations,
and the glory of your people Israel.”
33 Joseph and his mother were
marveling at the things which were
spoken concerning him.
34 Simeon blessed them, and said to
Mary, his mother, “Behold, this child is
appointed for the falling and the rising of
many in Israel, and for a sign which is
spoken against.
35 Yes, a sword will pierce through your
own soul, that the thoughts of many
hearts may be revealed.”
36 There was one Anna, a prophetess,
the daughter of Phanuel, of the tribe of
Asher (she was of a great age, having lived
with a husband seven years from her
virginity,
37 and she had been a widow for about
eighty-four years), who didn’t depart
from the temple, worshiping with fastings
and petitions night and day.
38 Coming up at that very hour, she gave
thanks to the Lord, and spoke of him to all
those who were looking for redemption in
Jerusalem.
39 When they had accomplished all
things that were according to the law of
the Lord, they returned into Galilee, to
their own city, Nazareth.
40 The child was growing, and was
becoming strong in spirit, being filled
with wisdom, and the grace of God was
upon him.
41 His parents went every year to
Jerusalem at the feast of the Passover.
42 When he was twelve years old, they
went up to Jerusalem according to the
custom of the feast;
43 and when they had fulfilled the days,
as they were returning, the boy Jesus
stayed behind in Jerusalem. Joseph and
his mother didn’t know it,

* **2:23** Exodus 13:2,12 * **2:24** Leviticus 12:8 ‡ **2:26** “Christ” (Greek) and “Messiah” (Hebrew) both mean “Anointed One”

44 but supposing him to be in the
company, they went a day's journey; and
they looked for him among their relatives
and acquaintances.
45 When they didn't find him, they
returned to Jerusalem, looking for him.
46 After three days they found him in
the temple, sitting in the middle of the
teachers, both listening to them and
asking them questions.
47 All who heard him were amazed at
his understanding and his answers.
48 When they saw him, they were
astonished; and his mother said to him,
"Son, why have you treated us this way?
Behold, your father and I were anxiously
looking for you."
49 He said to them, "Why were you
looking for me? Didn't you know that I
must be in my Father's house?"
50 They didn't understand the saying
which he spoke to them.
51 And he went down with them and
came to Nazareth. He was subject to
them, and his mother kept all these
sayings in her heart.
52 And Jesus increased in wisdom and
stature, and in favor with God and men.

3

1 Now in the fifteenth year of the reign
of Tiberius Caesar, Pontius Pilate being
governor of Judea, and Herod being
tetrarch of Galilee, and his brother Philip
tetrarch of the region of Ituraea and
Trachonitis, and Lysanias tetrarch of
Abilene,
2 during the high priesthood of Annas
and Caiaphas, the word of God came to
John, the son of Zacharias, in the
wilderness.
3 He came into all the region around the
Jordan, preaching the baptism of
repentance for remission of sins.
4 As it is written in the book of the words
of Isaiah the prophet,
"The voice of one crying in the wilderness,
'Make ready the way of the Lord.
Make his paths straight.
5 Every valley will be filled.
Every mountain and hill will be brought
low.
The crooked will become straight,
and the rough ways smooth.
6 All flesh will see God's salvation.' "*
7 He said therefore to the multitudes
who went out to be baptized by him, "You
offspring of vipers, who warned you to
flee from the wrath to come?
8 Therefore produce fruits worthy of
repentance, and don't begin to say among
yourselves, 'We have Abraham for our
father;' for I tell you that God is able to
raise up children to Abraham from these
stones!
9 Even now the ax also lies at the root of
the trees. Every tree therefore that
doesn't produce good fruit is cut down
and thrown into the fire."
10 The multitudes asked him, "What
then must we do?"
11 He answered them, "He who has two
coats, let him give to him who has none.
He who has food, let him do likewise."
12 Tax collectors also came to be
baptized, and they said to him, "Teacher,
what must we do?"
13 He said to them, "Collect no more
than that which is appointed to you."
14 Soldiers also asked him, saying,
"What about us? What must we do?"
He said to them, "Extort from no one by
violence, neither accuse anyone
wrongfully. Be content with your wages."
15 As the people were in expectation,
and all men reasoned in their hearts
concerning John, whether perhaps he was
the Christ,
16 John answered them all, "I indeed
baptize you with water, but he comes who
is mightier than I, the strap of whose
sandals I am not worthy to loosen. He will
baptize you in the Holy Spirit and fire.
17 His winnowing fan is in his hand, and
he will thoroughly cleanse his threshing
floor, and will gather the wheat into his
barn; but he will burn up the chaff with
unquenchable fire."
18 Then with many other exhortations
he preached good news to the people,

* **3:6** Isaiah 40:3-5 † **3:19** a tetrarch is one of four governors of a province

19 but Herod the tetrarch,† being
reproved by him for Herodias, his
brother's‡ wife, and for all the evil things
which Herod had done,
20 added this also to them all, that he
shut up John in prison.

21 Now when all the people were
baptized, Jesus also had been baptized
and was praying. The sky was opened,
22 and the Holy Spirit descended in a
bodily form like a dove on him; and a
voice came out of the sky, saying "You are
my beloved Son. In you I am well
pleased."

23 Jesus himself, when he began to
teach, was about thirty years old, being
the son (as was supposed) of Joseph, the
son of Heli,
24 the son of Matthat, the son of Levi, the
son of Melchi, the son of Jannai, the son of
Joseph,
25 the son of Mattathias, the son of
Amos, the son of Nahum, the son of Esli,
the son of Naggai,
26 the son of Maath, the son of
Mattathias, the son of Semein, the son of
Joseph, the son of Judah,
27 the son of Joanan, the son of Rhesa,
the son of Zerubbabel, the son of Shealtiel,
the son of Neri,
28 the son of Melchi, the son of Addi, the
son of Cosam, the son of Elmodam, the son
of Er,
29 the son of Jose, the son of Eliezer, the
son of Jorim, the son of Matthat, the son of
Levi,
30 the son of Simeon, the son of Judah,
the son of Joseph, the son of Jonan, the son
of Eliakim,
31 the son of Melea, the son of Menan,
the son of Mattatha, the son of Nathan, the
son of David,
32 the son of Jesse, the son of Obed, the
son of Boaz, the son of Salmon, the son of
Nahshon,
33 the son of Amminadab, the son of
Aram,§ the son of Hezron, the son of
Perez, the son of Judah,
34 the son of Jacob, the son of Isaac, the
son of Abraham, the son of Terah, the son
of Nahor,
35 the son of Serug, the son of Reu, the
son of Peleg, the son of Eber, the son of
Shelah,
36 the son of Cainan, the son of
Arphaxad, the son of Shem, the son of
Noah, the son of Lamech,
37 the son of Methuselah, the son of
Enoch, the son of Jared, the son of
Mahalaleel, the son of Cainan,
38 the son of Enos, the son of Seth, the
son of Adam, the son of God.

4

1 Jesus, full of the Holy Spirit, returned
from the Jordan and was led by the Spirit
into the wilderness
2 for forty days, being tempted by the
devil. He ate nothing in those days.
Afterward, when they were completed, he
was hungry.
3 The devil said to him, "If you are the
Son of God, command this stone to
become bread."
4 Jesus answered him, saying, "It is
written, 'Man shall not live by bread
alone, but by every word of God.' "*
5 The devil, leading him up on a high
mountain, showed him all the kingdoms
of the world in a moment of time.
6 The devil said to him, "I will give you
all this authority and their glory, for it has
been delivered to me, and I give it to
whomever I want.
7 If you therefore will worship before
me, it will all be yours."
8 Jesus answered him, "Get behind me,
Satan! For it is written, 'You shall worship
the Lord your God, and you shall serve
him only.' "*
9 He led him to Jerusalem and set him
on the pinnacle of the temple, and said to
him, "If you are the Son of God, cast
yourself down from here,
10 for it is written,
'He will put his angels in charge of you, to
guard you;'

‡ **3:19** TR reads "brother Philip's" instead of "brother's"
§ **3:33** NU reads "Admin, the son of Arni" instead of "Aram"
* **4:4** Deuteronomy 8:3
* **4:8** Deuteronomy 6:13

11 and,
‘On their hands they will bear you up,
lest perhaps you dash your foot
against a stone.’ ”*
12 Jesus answering, said to him, “It has
been said, ‘You shall not tempt the Lord
your God.’ ”*
13 When the devil had completed every
temptation, he departed from him until
another time.
14 Jesus returned in the power of the
Spirit into Galilee, and news about him
spread through all the surrounding area.
15 He taught in their synagogues, being
glorified by all.
16 He came to Nazareth, where he had
been brought up. He entered, as was his
custom, into the synagogue on the
Sabbath day, and stood up to read.
17 The book of the prophet Isaiah was
handed to him. He opened the book, and
found the place where it was written,
18 “The Spirit of the Lord is on me,
because he has anointed me to preach
good news to the poor.
He has sent me to heal the broken
hearted,†
to proclaim release to the captives,
recovering of sight to the blind,
to deliver those who are crushed,
19 and to proclaim the acceptable year
of the Lord.”*
20 He closed the book, gave it back to the
attendant, and sat down. The eyes of all in
the synagogue were fastened on him.
21 He began to tell them, “Today, this
Scripture has been fulfilled in your
hearing.”
22 All testified about him and wondered
at the gracious words which proceeded
out of his mouth; and they said, “Isn’t this
Joseph’s son?”
23 He said to them, “Doubtless you will
tell me this proverb, ‘Physician, heal
yourself! Whatever we have heard done
at Capernaum, do also here in your
hometown.’ ”
24 He said, “Most certainly I tell you, no
prophet is acceptable in his hometown.
25 But truly I tell you, there were many
widows in Israel in the days of Elijah,
when the sky was shut up three years and
six months, when a great famine came
over all the land.
26 Elijah was sent to none of them,
except to Zarephath, in the land of Sidon,
to a woman who was a widow.
27 There were many lepers in Israel in
the time of Elisha the prophet, yet not one
of them was cleansed, except Naaman, the
Syrian.”
28 They were all filled with wrath in the
synagogue as they heard these things.
29 They rose up, threw him out of the
city, and led him to the brow of the hill
that their city was built on, that they
might throw him off the cliff.
30 But he, passing through the middle of
them, went his way.
31 He came down to Capernaum, a city
of Galilee. He was teaching them on the
Sabbath day,
32 and they were astonished at his
teaching, for his word was with authority.
33 In the synagogue there was a man
who had a spirit of an unclean demon;
and he cried out with a loud voice,
34 saying, “Ah! what have we to do with
you, Jesus of Nazareth? Have you come to
destroy us? I know who you are: the Holy
One of God!”
35 Jesus rebuked him, saying, “Be silent
and come out of him!” When the demon
had thrown him down in the middle of
them, he came out of him, having done
him no harm.
36 Amazement came on all and they
spoke together, one with another, saying,
“What is this word? For with authority
and power he commands the unclean
spirits, and they come out!”
37 News about him went out into every
place of the surrounding region.
38 He rose up from the synagogue and
entered into Simon’s house. Simon’s
mother-in-law was afflicted with a great
fever, and they begged him to help her.

* **4:11** Psalms 91:11-12 * **4:12** Deuteronomy 6:16 † **4:18** NU omits “to heal the broken hearted” * **4:19** Isaiah 61:1-2

39 He stood over her and rebuked the fever, and it left her. Immediately she rose up and served them.
40 When the sun was setting, all those who had any sick with various diseases brought them to him; and he laid his hands on every one of them, and healed them.
41 Demons also came out of many, crying out and saying, "You are the Christ, the Son of God!" Rebuking them, he didn't allow them to speak, because they knew that he was the Christ.
42 When it was day, he departed and went into an uninhabited place and the multitudes looked for him, and came to him, and held on to him, so that he wouldn't go away from them.
43 But he said to them, "I must preach the good news of God's Kingdom to the other cities also. For this reason I have been sent."
44 He was preaching in the synagogues of Galilee.

5

1 Now while the multitude pressed on him and heard the word of God, he was standing by the lake of Gennesaret.
2 He saw two boats standing by the lake, but the fishermen had gone out of them and were washing their nets.
3 He entered into one of the boats, which was Simon's, and asked him to put out a little from the land. He sat down and taught the multitudes from the boat.
4 When he had finished speaking, he said to Simon, "Put out into the deep and let down your nets for a catch."
5 Simon answered him, "Master, we worked all night and caught nothing; but at your word I will let down the net."
6 When they had done this, they caught a great multitude of fish, and their net was breaking.
7 They beckoned to their partners in the other boat, that they should come and help them. They came and filled both boats, so that they began to sink.
8 But Simon Peter, when he saw it, fell down at Jesus' knees, saying, "Depart from me, for I am a sinful man, Lord."
9 For he was amazed, and all who were with him, at the catch of fish which they had caught;
10 and so also were James and John, sons of Zebedee, who were partners with Simon.
Jesus said to Simon, "Don't be afraid. From now on you will be catching people alive."
11 When they had brought their boats to land, they left everything, and followed him.
12 While he was in one of the cities, behold, there was a man full of leprosy. When he saw Jesus, he fell on his face and begged him, saying, "Lord, if you want to, you can make me clean."
13 He stretched out his hand and touched him, saying, "I want to. Be made clean."
Immediately the leprosy left him.
14 He commanded him to tell no one, "But go your way and show yourself to the priest, and offer for your cleansing according to what Moses commanded, for a testimony to them."
15 But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear and to be healed by him of their infirmities.
16 But he withdrew himself into the desert and prayed.
17 On one of those days, he was teaching; and there were Pharisees and teachers of the law sitting by who had come out of every village of Galilee, Judea, and Jerusalem. The power of the Lord was with him to heal them.
18 Behold, men brought a paralyzed man on a cot, and they sought to bring him in to lay before Jesus.
19 Not finding a way to bring him in because of the multitude, they went up to the housetop and let him down through the tiles with his cot into the middle before Jesus.
20 Seeing their faith, he said to him, "Man, your sins are forgiven you."
21 The scribes and the Pharisees began to reason, saying, "Who is this who speaks blasphemies? Who can forgive sins, but God alone?"

22 But Jesus, perceiving their thoughts,
answered them, "Why are you reasoning
so in your hearts?
23 Which is easier to say, 'Your sins are
forgiven you,' or to say, 'Arise and walk'?
24 But that you may know that the Son of
Man has authority on earth to forgive
sins," he said to the paralyzed man, "I tell
you, arise, take up your cot, and go to your
house."
25 Immediately he rose up before them,
and took up that which he was laying on,
and departed to his house, glorifying God.
26 Amazement took hold on all, and they
glorified God. They were filled with fear,
saying, "We have seen strange things
today."
27 After these things he went out and
saw a tax collector named Levi sitting at
the tax office, and said to him, "Follow
me!"
28 He left everything, and rose up and
followed him.
29 Levi made a great feast for him in his
house. There was a great crowd of tax
collectors and others who were reclining
with them.
30 Their scribes and the Pharisees
murmured against his disciples, saying,
"Why do you eat and drink with the tax
collectors and sinners?"
31 Jesus answered them, "Those who are
healthy have no need for a physician, but
those who are sick do.
32 I have not come to call the righteous,
but sinners, to repentance."
33 They said to him, "Why do John's
disciples often fast and pray, likewise also
the disciples of the Pharisees, but yours
eat and drink?"
34 He said to them, "Can you make the
friends of the bridegroom fast while the
bridegroom is with them?
35 But the days will come when the
bridegroom will be taken away from
them. Then they will fast in those days."
36 He also told a parable to them. "No
one puts a piece from a new garment on
an old garment, or else he will tear the
new, and also the piece from the new will
not match the old.
37 No one puts new wine into old
wineskins, or else the new wine will burst
the skins, and it will be spilled and the
skins will be destroyed.
38 But new wine must be put into fresh
wineskins, and both are preserved.
39 No man having drunk old wine
immediately desires new, for he says, 'The
old is better.' "

6

1 Now on the second Sabbath after the
first, he was going through the grain
fields. His disciples plucked the heads of
grain and ate, rubbing them in their
hands.
2 But some of the Pharisees said to them,
"Why do you do that which is not lawful to
do on the Sabbath day?"
3 Jesus, answering them, said, "Haven't
you read what David did when he was
hungry, he and those who were with him,
4 how he entered into God's house, and
took and ate the show bread, and gave
also to those who were with him, which is
not lawful to eat except for the priests
alone?"
5 He said to them, "The Son of Man is
lord of the Sabbath."
6 It also happened on another Sabbath
that he entered into the synagogue and
taught. There was a man there, and his
right hand was withered.
7 The scribes and the Pharisees watched
him, to see whether he would heal on the
Sabbath, that they might find an
accusation against him.
8 But he knew their thoughts; and he
said to the man who had the withered
hand, "Rise up and stand in the middle."
He arose and stood.
9 Then Jesus said to them, "I will ask you
something: Is it lawful on the Sabbath to
do good, or to do harm? To save a life, or
to kill?"
10 He looked around at them all, and
said to the man, "Stretch out your hand."
He did, and his hand was restored as
sound as the other.
11 But they were filled with rage, and
talked with one another about what they
might do to Jesus.

12 In these days, he went out to the
mountain to pray, and he continued all
night in prayer to God.
13 When it was day, he called his
disciples, and from them he chose twelve,
whom he also named apostles:
14 Simon, whom he also named Peter;
Andrew, his brother; James; John; Philip;
Bartholomew;
15 Matthew; Thomas; James the son of
Alphaeus; Simon who was called the
Zealot;
16 Judas the son of James; and Judas
Iscariot, who also became a traitor.
17 He came down with them and stood
on a level place, with a crowd of his
disciples and a great number of the people
from all Judea and Jerusalem and the sea
coast of Tyre and Sidon, who came to hear
him and to be healed of their diseases,
18 as well as those who were troubled by
unclean spirits; and they were being
healed.
19 All the multitude sought to touch him,
for power came out of him and healed
them all.
20 He lifted up his eyes to his disciples,
and said:
"Blessed are you who are poor,
for God's Kingdom is yours.
21 Blessed are you who hunger now,
for you will be filled.
Blessed are you who weep now,
for you will laugh.
22 Blessed are you when men hate you,
and when they exclude and mock
you, and throw out your name as
evil, for the Son of Man's sake.
23 Rejoice in that day and leap for joy,
for behold, your reward is great in
heaven, for their fathers did the
same thing to the prophets.

24 "But woe to you who are rich!
For you have received your
consolation.
25 Woe to you, you who are full now,
for you will be hungry.
Woe to you who laugh now,
for you will mourn and weep.
26 Woe,† when‡ men speak well of you,
for their fathers did the same thing to
the false prophets.
27 "But I tell you who hear: love your
enemies, do good to those who hate you,
28 bless those who curse you, and pray
for those who mistreat you.
29 To him who strikes you on the cheek,
offer also the other; and from him who
takes away your cloak, don't withhold
your coat also.
30 Give to everyone who asks you, and
don't ask him who takes away your goods
to give them back again.
31 "As you would like people to do to
you, do exactly so to them.
32 "If you love those who love you, what
credit is that to you? For even sinners love
those who love them.
33 If you do good to those who do good to
you, what credit is that to you? For even
sinners do the same.
34 If you lend to those from whom you
hope to receive, what credit is that to you?
Even sinners lend to sinners, to receive
back as much.
35 But love your enemies, and do good,
and lend, expecting nothing back; and
your reward will be great, and you will be
children of the Most High; for he is kind
toward the unthankful and evil.
36 "Therefore be merciful,
even as your Father is also merciful.
37 Don't judge,
and you won't be judged.
Don't condemn,
and you won't be condemned.
Set free,
and you will be set free.
38 "Give, and it will be given to you:
good measure, pressed down, shaken
together, and running over, will be given
to you.§ For with the same measure you
measure it will be measured back to you."
39 He spoke a parable to them. "Can the
blind guide the blind? Won't they both fall
into a pit?
40 A disciple is not above his teacher, but
everyone when he is fully trained will be
like his teacher.

† **6:26** TR adds "to you" ‡ **6:26** TR adds "all" § **6:38** literally, into your bosom.

41 Why do you see the speck of chaff that
is in your brother's eye, but don't consider
the beam that is in your own eye?
42 Or how can you tell your brother,
'Brother, let me remove the speck of chaff
that is in your eye,' when you yourself
don't see the beam that is in your own
eye? You hypocrite! First remove the
beam from your own eye, and then you
can see clearly to remove the speck of
chaff that is in your brother's eye.
43 "For there is no good tree that
produces rotten fruit, nor again a rotten
tree that produces good fruit.
44 For each tree is known by its own
fruit. For people don't gather figs from
thorns, nor do they gather grapes from a
bramble bush.
45 The good man out of the good
treasure of his heart brings out that which
is good, and the evil man out of the evil
treasure of his heart brings out that which
is evil, for out of the abundance of the
heart, his mouth speaks.
46 "Why do you call me, 'Lord, Lord,' and
don't do the things which I say?
47 Everyone who comes to me, and
hears my words and does them, I will
show you who he is like.
48 He is like a man building a house,
who dug and went deep and laid a
foundation on the rock. When a flood
arose, the stream broke against that
house, and could not shake it, because it
was founded on the rock.
49 But he who hears and doesn't do, is
like a man who built a house on the earth
without a foundation, against which the
stream broke, and immediately it fell; and
the ruin of that house was great."

7

1 After he had finished speaking in the
hearing of the people, he entered into
Capernaum.
2 A certain centurion's servant, who was
dear to him, was sick and at the point of
death.
3 When he heard about Jesus, he sent to
him elders of the Jews, asking him to
come and save his servant.
4 When they came to Jesus, they begged
him earnestly, saying, "He is worthy for
you to do this for him,
5 for he loves our nation, and he built
our synagogue for us."
6 Jesus went with them. When he was
now not far from the house, the centurion
sent friends to him, saying to him, "Lord,
don't trouble yourself, for I am not worthy
for you to come under my roof.
7 Therefore I didn't even think myself
worthy to come to you; but say the word,
and my servant will be healed.
8 For I also am a man placed under
authority, having under myself soldiers. I
tell this one, 'Go!' and he goes; and to
another, 'Come!' and he comes; and to my
servant, 'Do this,' and he does it."
9 When Jesus heard these things, he
marveled at him, and turned and said to
the multitude who followed him, "I tell
you, I have not found such great faith, no,
not in Israel."
10 Those who were sent, returning to the
house, found that the servant who had
been sick was well.
11 Soon afterwards, he went to a city
called Nain. Many of his disciples, along
with a great multitude, went with him.
12 Now when he came near to the gate of
the city, behold, one who was dead was
carried out, the only born† son of his
mother, and she was a widow. Many
people of the city were with her.
13 When the Lord saw her, he had
compassion on her and said to her, "Don't
cry."
14 He came near and touched the coffin,
and the bearers stood still. He said,
"Young man, I tell you, arise!"
15 He who was dead sat up and began to
speak. Then he gave him to his mother.
16 Fear took hold of all, and they
glorified God, saying, "A great prophet has
arisen among us!" and, "God has visited
his people!"

† **7:12** The phrase "only born" is from the Greek word "μονογενη", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only".

17 This report went out concerning him
in the whole of Judea and in all the
surrounding region.
18 The disciples of John told him about
all these things.
19 John, calling to himself two of his
disciples, sent them to Jesus, saying, “Are
you the one who is coming, or should we
look for another?”
20 When the men had come to him, they
said, “John the Baptizer has sent us to you,
saying, ‘Are you he who comes, or should
we look for another?’ ”
21 In that hour he cured many of
diseases and plagues and evil spirits; and
to many who were blind he gave sight.
22 Jesus answered them, “Go and tell
John the things which you have seen and
heard: that the blind receive their sight,
the lame walk, the lepers are cleansed, the
deaf hear, the dead are raised up, and the
poor have good news preached to them.
23 Blessed is he who finds no occasion
for stumbling in me.”
24 When John’s messengers had
departed, he began to tell the multitudes
about John, “What did you go out into the
wilderness to see? A reed shaken by the
wind?
25 But what did you go out to see? A man
clothed in soft clothing? Behold, those
who are gorgeously dressed and live
delicately are in kings’ courts.
26 But what did you go out to see? A
prophet? Yes, I tell you, and much more
than a prophet.
27 This is he of whom it is written,
‘Behold, I send my messenger before your
face,
who will prepare your way before
you.’*
28 “For I tell you, among those who are
born of women there is not a greater
prophet than John the Baptizer; yet he
who is least in God’s Kingdom is greater
than he.”
29 When all the people and the tax
collectors heard this, they declared God to
be just, having been baptized with John’s
baptism.
30 But the Pharisees and the lawyers
rejected the counsel of God, not being
baptized by him themselves.
31 ‡“To what then should I compare the
people of this generation? What are they
like?
32 They are like children who sit in the
marketplace and call to one another,
saying, ‘We piped to you, and you didn’t
dance. We mourned, and you didn’t
weep.’
33 For John the Baptizer came neither
eating bread nor drinking wine, and you
say, ‘He has a demon.’
34 The Son of Man has come eating and
drinking, and you say, ‘Behold, a glutton
and a drunkard, a friend of tax collectors
and sinners!’
35 Wisdom is justified by all her
children.”
36 One of the Pharisees invited him to
eat with him. He entered into the
Pharisee’s house and sat at the table.
37 Behold, a woman in the city who was
a sinner, when she knew that he was
reclining in the Pharisee’s house, brought
an alabaster jar of ointment.
38 Standing behind at his feet weeping,
she began to wet his feet with her tears,
and she wiped them with the hair of her
head, kissed his feet, and anointed them
with the ointment.
39 Now when the Pharisee who had
invited him saw it, he said to himself,
“This man, if he were a prophet, would
have perceived who and what kind of
woman this is who touches him, that she
is a sinner.”
40 Jesus answered him, “Simon, I have
something to tell you.”
He said, “Teacher, say on.”
41 “A certain lender had two debtors.
The one owed five hundred denarii, and
the other fifty.
42 When they couldn’t pay, he forgave
them both. Which of them therefore will
love him most?”
43 Simon answered, “He, I suppose, to
whom he forgave the most.”
He said to him, “You have judged
correctly.”

* **7:27** Malachi 3:1 ‡ **7:31** TR adds “But the Lord said,”

44 Turning to the woman, he said to
Simon, "Do you see this woman? I entered
into your house, and you gave me no
water for my feet, but she has wet my feet
with her tears, and wiped them with the
hair of her head.
45 You gave me no kiss, but she, since the
time I came in, has not ceased to kiss my
feet.
46 You didn't anoint my head with oil,
but she has anointed my feet with
ointment.
47 Therefore I tell you, her sins, which
are many, are forgiven, for she loved
much. But one to whom little is forgiven,
loves little."
48 He said to her, "Your sins are
forgiven."
49 Those who sat at the table with him
began to say to themselves, "Who is this
who even forgives sins?"
50 He said to the woman, "Your faith has
saved you. Go in peace."

8

1 Soon afterwards, he went about
through cities and villages, preaching and
bringing the good news of God's Kingdom.
With him were the twelve,
2 and certain women who had been
healed of evil spirits and infirmities: Mary
who was called Magdalene, from whom
seven demons had gone out;
3 and Joanna, the wife of Chuzas,
Herod's steward; Susanna; and many
others who served them† from their
possessions.
4 When a great multitude came together
and people from every city were coming
to him, he spoke by a parable:
5 "The farmer went out to sow his seed.
As he sowed, some fell along the road, and
it was trampled under foot, and the birds
of the sky devoured it.
6 Some seed fell on the rock, and as soon
as it grew, it withered away, because it
had no moisture.
7 Some fell amid the thorns, and the
thorns grew with it and choked it.
8 Some fell into the good ground and
grew and produced one hundred times as
much fruit." As he said these things, he
called out, "He who has ears to hear, let
him hear!"
9 Then his disciples asked him, "What
does this parable mean?"
10 He said, "To you it is given to know
the mysteries of God's Kingdom, but to the
rest it is given in parables, that 'seeing
they may not see, and hearing they may
not understand.'*
11 "Now the parable is this: The seed is
the word of God.
12 Those along the road are those who
hear; then the devil comes and takes away
the word from their heart, that they may
not believe and be saved.
13 Those on the rock are they who, when
they hear, receive the word with joy; but
these have no root. They believe for a
while, then fall away in time of
temptation.
14 What fell among the thorns, these are
those who have heard, and as they go on
their way they are choked with cares,
riches, and pleasures of life; and they
bring no fruit to maturity.
15 Those in the good ground, these are
those who with an honest and good heart,
having heard the word, hold it tightly, and
produce fruit with perseverance.
16 "No one, when he has lit a lamp,
covers it with a container or puts it under
a bed; but puts it on a stand, that those
who enter in may see the light.
17 For nothing is hidden that will not be
revealed, nor anything secret that will not
be known and come to light.
18 Be careful therefore how you hear.
For whoever has, to him will be given; and
whoever doesn't have, from him will be
taken away even that which he thinks he
has."
19 His mother and brothers came to him,
and they could not come near him for the
crowd.
20 Some people told him, "Your mother
and your brothers stand outside, desiring
to see you."

† **8:3** TR reads "him" instead of "them" * **8:10** Isaiah 6:9

21 But he answered them, “My mother
and my brothers are these who hear the
word of God and do it.”
22 Now on one of those days, he entered
into a boat, himself and his disciples, and
he said to them, “Let’s go over to the other
side of the lake.” So they launched out.
23 But as they sailed, he fell asleep. A
wind storm came down on the lake, and
they were taking on dangerous amounts
of water.
24 They came to him and awoke him,
saying, “Master, Master, we are dying!”
He awoke and rebuked the wind and the
raging of the water; then they ceased, and
it was calm.*
25 He said to them, “Where is your
faith?” Being afraid, they marveled,
saying to one another, “Who is this then,
that he commands even the winds and the
water, and they obey him?”
26 Then they arrived at the country of
the Gadarenes, which is opposite Galilee.
27 When Jesus stepped ashore, a certain
man out of the city who had demons for a
long time met him. He wore no clothes,
and didn’t live in a house, but in the
tombs.
28 When he saw Jesus, he cried out and
fell down before him, and with a loud
voice said, “What do I have to do with you,
Jesus, you Son of the Most High God? I beg
you, don’t torment me!”
29 For Jesus was commanding the
unclean spirit to come out of the man. For
the unclean spirit had often seized the
man. He was kept under guard and bound
with chains and fetters. Breaking the
bonds apart, he was driven by the demon
into the desert.
30 Jesus asked him, “What is your
name?”
He said, “Legion,” for many demons had
entered into him.
31 They begged him that he would not
command them to go into the abyss.
32 Now there was there a herd of many
pigs feeding on the mountain, and they
begged him that he would allow them to
enter into those. Then he allowed them.
33 The demons came out of the man and
entered into the pigs, and the herd rushed
down the steep bank into the lake and
were drowned.
34 When those who fed them saw what
had happened, they fled and told it in the
city and in the country.
35 People went out to see what had
happened. They came to Jesus and found
the man from whom the demons had
gone out, sitting at Jesus’ feet, clothed and
in his right mind; and they were afraid.
36 Those who saw it told them how he
who had been possessed by demons was
healed.
37 All the people of the surrounding
country of the Gadarenes asked him to
depart from them, for they were very
much afraid. Then he entered into the
boat and returned.
38 But the man from whom the demons
had gone out begged him that he might go
with him, but Jesus sent him away, saying,
39 “Return to your house, and declare
what great things God has done for you.”
He went his way, proclaiming throughout
the whole city what great things Jesus had
done for him.
40 When Jesus returned, the multitude
welcomed him, for they were all waiting
for him.
41 Behold, a man named Jairus came. He
was a ruler of the synagogue. He fell
down at Jesus’ feet and begged him to
come into his house,
42 for he had an only born‡ daughter,
about twelve years of age, and she was
dying. But as he went, the multitudes
pressed against him.
43 A woman who had a flow of blood for
twelve years, who had spent all her living
on physicians and could not be healed by
any,
44 came behind him and touched the
fringe§ of his cloak. Immediately the flow
of her blood stopped.
45 Jesus said, “Who touched me?”
When all denied it, Peter and those with
him said, “Master, the multitudes press

* **8:24** See Psalms 107:29 ‡ **8:42** The phrase “only born” is from the Greek word “μονογενη”, which is sometimes translated “only begotten” or “one and only”. § **8:44** or, tassel

and jostle you, and you say, 'Who touched me?'"
46 But Jesus said, "Someone did touch me, for I perceived that power has gone out of me."
47 When the woman saw that she was not hidden, she came trembling; and falling down before him declared to him in the presence of all the people the reason why she had touched him, and how she was healed immediately.
48 He said to her, "Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace."
49 While he still spoke, one from the ruler of the synagogue's house came, saying to him, "Your daughter is dead. Don't trouble the Teacher."
50 But Jesus hearing it, answered him, "Don't be afraid. Only believe, and she will be healed."
51 When he came to the house, he didn't allow anyone to enter in, except Peter, John, James, the father of the child, and her mother.
52 All were weeping and mourning her, but he said, "Don't weep. She isn't dead, but sleeping."
53 They were ridiculing him, knowing that she was dead.
54 But he put them all outside, and taking her by the hand, he called, saying, "Child, arise!"
55 Her spirit returned, and she rose up immediately. He commanded that something be given to her to eat.
56 Her parents were amazed, but he commanded them to tell no one what had been done.

9

1 He called the twelve† together and gave them power and authority over all demons, and to cure diseases.
2 He sent them out to preach God's Kingdom and to heal the sick.
3 He said to them, "Take nothing for your journey—no staffs, nor wallet, nor bread, nor money. Don't have two tunics each.
4 Into whatever house you enter, stay there, and depart from there.
5 As many as don't receive you, when you depart from that city, shake off even the dust from your feet for a testimony against them."
6 They departed and went throughout the villages, preaching the Good News and healing everywhere.
7 Now Herod the tetrarch heard of all that was done by him; and he was very perplexed, because it was said by some that John had risen from the dead,
8 and by some that Elijah had appeared, and by others that one of the old prophets had risen again.
9 Herod said, "I beheaded John, but who is this about whom I hear such things?" He sought to see him.
10 The apostles, when they had returned, told him what things they had done.
He took them and withdrew apart to a desert region of‡ a city called Bethsaida.
11 But the multitudes, perceiving it, followed him. He welcomed them, spoke to them of God's Kingdom, and he cured those who needed healing.
12 The day began to wear away; and the twelve came and said to him, "Send the multitude away, that they may go into the surrounding villages and farms and lodge and get food, for we are here in a deserted place."
13 But he said to them, "You give them something to eat."
They said, "We have no more than five loaves and two fish, unless we should go and buy food for all these people."
14 For they were about five thousand men.
He said to his disciples, "Make them sit down in groups of about fifty each."
15 They did so, and made them all sit down.
16 He took the five loaves and the two fish, and looking up to the sky, he blessed them, broke them, and gave them to the disciples to set before the multitude.

† **9:1** TR reads "his twelve disciples" instead of "the twelve"
‡ **9:10** NU omits "a desert region of".

17 They ate and were all filled. They
gathered up twelve baskets of broken
pieces that were left over.
18 As he was praying alone, the disciples
were near him, and he asked them, "Who
do the multitudes say that I am?"
19 They answered, " 'John the Baptizer,'
but others say, 'Elijah,' and others, that
one of the old prophets has risen again."
20 He said to them, "But who do you say
that I am?"
Peter answered, "The Christ of God."
21 But he warned them and commanded
them to tell this to no one,
22 saying, "The Son of Man must suffer
many things, and be rejected by the
elders, chief priests, and scribes, and be
killed, and the third day be raised up."
23 He said to all, "If anyone desires to
come after me, let him deny himself, take
up his cross,§ and follow me.
24 For whoever desires to save his life
will lose it, but whoever will lose his life
for my sake will save it.
25 For what does it profit a man if he
gains the whole world, and loses or
forfeits his own self?
26 For whoever will be ashamed of me
and of my words, of him will the Son of
Man be ashamed when he comes in his
glory, and the glory of the Father, and of
the holy angels.
27 But I tell you the truth: There are
some of those who stand here who will in
no way taste of death until they see God's
Kingdom."
28 About eight days after these sayings,
he took with him Peter, John, and James,
and went up onto the mountain to pray.
29 As he was praying, the appearance of
his face was altered, and his clothing
became white and dazzling.
30 Behold, two men were talking with
him, who were Moses and Elijah,
31 who appeared in glory and spoke of
his departure,† which he was about to
accomplish at Jerusalem.
32 Now Peter and those who were with
him were heavy with sleep, but when they
were fully awake, they saw his glory, and
the two men who stood with him.
33 As they were parting from him, Peter
said to Jesus, "Master, it is good for us to
be here. Let's make three tents: one for
you, one for Moses, and one for Elijah,"
not knowing what he said.
34 While he said these things, a cloud
came and overshadowed them, and they
were afraid as they entered into the cloud.
35 A voice came out of the cloud, saying,
"This is my beloved Son. Listen to him!"
36 When the voice came, Jesus was
found alone. They were silent, and told no
one in those days any of the things which
they had seen.
37 On the next day, when they had come
down from the mountain, a great
multitude met him.
38 Behold, a man from the crowd called
out, saying, "Teacher, I beg you to look at
my son, for he is my only born‡ child.
39 Behold, a spirit takes him, he
suddenly cries out, and it convulses him
so that he foams; and it hardly departs
from him, bruising him severely.
40 I begged your disciples to cast it out,
and they couldn't."
41 Jesus answered, "Faithless and
perverse generation, how long shall I be
with you and bear with you? Bring your
son here."
42 While he was still coming, the demon
threw him down and convulsed him
violently. But Jesus rebuked the unclean
spirit, healed the boy, and gave him back
to his father.
43 They were all astonished at the
majesty of God.
But while all were marveling at all the
things which Jesus did, he said to his
disciples,
44 "Let these words sink into your ears,
for the Son of Man will be delivered up
into the hands of men."
45 But they didn't understand this
saying. It was concealed from them, that
they should not perceive it, and they were
afraid to ask him about this saying.

§ **9:23** TR, NU add "daily" † **9:31** literally, "exodus" ‡ **9:38** The phrase "only born" is from the Greek word "μονογενη", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only".

46 An argument arose among them
about which of them was the greatest.
47 Jesus, perceiving the reasoning of
their hearts, took a little child, and set him
by his side,
48 and said to them, "Whoever receives
this little child in my name receives me.
Whoever receives me receives him who
sent me. For whoever is least among you
all, this one will be great."
49 John answered, "Master, we saw
someone casting out demons in your
name, and we forbade him, because he
doesn't follow with us."
50 Jesus said to him, "Don't forbid him,
for he who is not against us is for us."
51 It came to pass, when the days were
near that he should be taken up, he
intently set his face to go to Jerusalem
52 and sent messengers before his face.
They went and entered into a village of
the Samaritans, so as to prepare for him.
53 They didn't receive him, because he
was traveling with his face set toward
Jerusalem.
54 When his disciples, James and John,
saw this, they said, "Lord, do you want us
to command fire to come down from the
sky and destroy them, just as Elijah did?"
55 But he turned and rebuked them,
"You don't know of what kind of spirit you
are.
56 For the Son of Man didn't come to
destroy men's lives, but to save them."
They went to another village.
57 As they went on the way, a certain
man said to him, "I want to follow you
wherever you go, Lord."
58 Jesus said to him, "The foxes have
holes and the birds of the sky have nests,
but the Son of Man has no place to lay his
head."
59 He said to another, "Follow me!"
But he said, "Lord, allow me first to go
and bury my father."
60 But Jesus said to him, "Leave the dead
to bury their own dead, but you go and
announce God's Kingdom."
61 Another also said, "I want to follow
you, Lord, but first allow me to say
good-bye to those who are at my house."
62 But Jesus said to him, "No one, having
put his hand to the plow and looking back,
is fit for God's Kingdom."

10

1 Now after these things, the Lord also
appointed seventy others, and sent them
two by two ahead of him† into every city
and place where he was about to come.
2 Then he said to them, "The harvest is
indeed plentiful, but the laborers are few.
Pray therefore to the Lord of the harvest,
that he may send out laborers into his
harvest.
3 Go your ways. Behold, I send you out
as lambs among wolves.
4 Carry no purse, nor wallet, nor
sandals. Greet no one on the way.
5 Into whatever house you enter, first
say, 'Peace be to this house.'
6 If a son of peace is there, your peace
will rest on him; but if not, it will return to
you.
7 Remain in that same house, eating and
drinking the things they give, for the
laborer is worthy of his wages. Don't go
from house to house.
8 Into whatever city you enter and they
receive you, eat the things that are set
before you.
9 Heal the sick who are there and tell
them, 'God's Kingdom has come near to
you.'
10 But into whatever city you enter and
they don't receive you, go out into its
streets and say,
11 'Even the dust from your city that
clings to us, we wipe off against you.
Nevertheless know this, that God's
Kingdom has come near to you.'
12 I tell you, it will be more tolerable in
that day for Sodom than for that city.
13 "Woe to you, Chorazin! Woe to you,
Bethsaida! For if the mighty works had
been done in Tyre and Sidon which were
done in you, they would have repented
long ago, sitting in sackcloth and ashes.

† **10:1** literally, "before his face" ‡ **10:15** Hades is the lower realm of the dead, or Hell.

14 But it will be more tolerable for Tyre
and Sidon in the judgment than for you.
15 You, Capernaum, who are exalted to
heaven, will be brought down to Hades. ‡
16 Whoever listens to you listens to me,
and whoever rejects you rejects me.
Whoever rejects me rejects him who sent
me."
17 The seventy returned with joy,
saying, "Lord, even the demons are
subject to us in your name!"
18 He said to them, "I saw Satan having
fallen like lightning from heaven.
19 Behold, I give you authority to tread
on serpents and scorpions, and over all
the power of the enemy. Nothing will in
any way hurt you.
20 Nevertheless, don't rejoice in this,
that the spirits are subject to you, but
rejoice that your names are written in
heaven."
21 In that same hour, Jesus rejoiced in
the Holy Spirit, and said, "I thank you, O
Father, Lord of heaven and earth, that you
have hidden these things from the wise
and understanding, and revealed them to
little children. Yes, Father, for so it was
well-pleasing in your sight."
22 Turning to the disciples, he said, "All
things have been delivered to me by my
Father. No one knows who the Son is,
except the Father, and who the Father is,
except the Son, and he to whomever the
Son desires to reveal him."
23 Turning to the disciples, he said
privately, "Blessed are the eyes which see
the things that you see,
24 for I tell you that many prophets and
kings desired to see the things which you
see, and didn't see them, and to hear the
things which you hear, and didn't hear
them."
25 Behold, a certain lawyer stood up and
tested him, saying, "Teacher, what shall I
do to inherit eternal life?"
26 He said to him, "What is written in the
law? How do you read it?"
27 He answered, "You shall love the Lord
your God with all your heart, with all your
soul, with all your strength, and with all
your mind;* and your neighbor as
yourself."*
28 He said to him, "You have answered
correctly. Do this, and you will live."
29 But he, desiring to justify himself,
asked Jesus, "Who is my neighbor?"
30 Jesus answered, "A certain man was
going down from Jerusalem to Jericho,
and he fell among robbers, who both
stripped him and beat him, and departed,
leaving him half dead.
31 By chance a certain priest was going
down that way. When he saw him, he
passed by on the other side.
32 In the same way a Levite also, when
he came to the place and saw him, passed
by on the other side.
33 But a certain Samaritan, as he
traveled, came where he was. When he
saw him, he was moved with compassion,
34 came to him, and bound up his
wounds, pouring on oil and wine. He set
him on his own animal, brought him to an
inn, and took care of him.
35 On the next day, when he departed,
he took out two denarii, gave them to the
host, and said to him, 'Take care of him.
Whatever you spend beyond that, I will
repay you when I return.'
36 Now which of these three do you
think seemed to be a neighbor to him who
fell among the robbers?"
37 He said, "He who showed mercy on
him."
Then Jesus said to him, "Go and do
likewise."
38 As they went on their way, he entered
into a certain village, and a certain
woman named Martha received him into
her house.
39 She had a sister called Mary, who also
sat at Jesus' feet and heard his word.
40 But Martha was distracted with much
serving, and she came up to him, and said,
"Lord, don't you care that my sister left
me to serve alone? Ask her therefore to
help me."
41 Jesus answered her, "Martha, Martha,
you are anxious and troubled about many
things,

* **10:27** Deuteronomy 6:5 * **10:27** Leviticus 19:18

42 but one thing is needed. Mary has
chosen the good part, which will not be
taken away from her."

11

1 When he finished praying in a certain
place, one of his disciples said to him,
"Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also
taught his disciples."
2 He said to them, "When you pray, say,
'Our Father in heaven,
may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.
May your will be done on earth, as it
is in heaven.
3 Give us day by day our daily bread.
4 Forgive us our sins,
for we ourselves also forgive
everyone who is indebted to us.
Bring us not into temptation,
but deliver us from the evil one.' "
5 He said to them, "Which of you, if you
go to a friend at midnight and tell him,
'Friend, lend me three loaves of bread,
6 for a friend of mine has come to me
from a journey, and I have nothing to set
before him,'
7 and he from within will answer and
say, 'Don't bother me. The door is now
shut, and my children are with me in bed.
I can't get up and give it to you'?
8 I tell you, although he will not rise and
give it to him because he is his friend, yet
because of his persistence, he will get up
and give him as many as he needs.
9 "I tell you, keep asking, and it will be
given you. Keep seeking, and you will
find. Keep knocking, and it will be opened
to you.
10 For everyone who asks receives. He
who seeks finds. To him who knocks it
will be opened.
11 "Which of you fathers, if your son
asks for bread, will give him a stone? Or if
he asks for a fish, he won't give him a
snake instead of a fish, will he?
12 Or if he asks for an egg, he won't give
him a scorpion, will he?
13 If you then, being evil, know how to
give good gifts to your children, how
much more will your heavenly Father
give the Holy Spirit to those who ask
him?"
14 He was casting out a demon, and it
was mute. When the demon had gone out,
the mute man spoke; and the multitudes
marveled.
15 But some of them said, "He casts out
demons by Beelzebul, the prince of the
demons."
16 Others, testing him, sought from him
a sign from heaven.
17 But he, knowing their thoughts, said
to them, "Every kingdom divided against
itself is brought to desolation. A house
divided against itself falls.
18 If Satan also is divided against
himself, how will his kingdom stand? For
you say that I cast out demons by
Beelzebul.
19 But if I cast out demons by Beelzebul,
by whom do your children cast them out?
Therefore they will be your judges.
20 But if I by God's finger cast out
demons, then God's Kingdom has come to
you.
21 "When the strong man, fully armed,
guards his own dwelling, his goods are
safe.
22 But when someone stronger attacks
him and overcomes him, he takes from
him his whole armor in which he trusted,
and divides his plunder.
23 "He who is not with me is against me.
He who doesn't gather with me scatters.
24 The unclean spirit, when he has gone
out of the man, passes through dry places,
seeking rest; and finding none, he says, 'I
will turn back to my house from which I
came out.'
25 When he returns, he finds it swept
and put in order.
26 Then he goes and takes seven other
spirits more evil than himself, and they
enter in and dwell there. The last state of
that man becomes worse than the first."
27 It came to pass, as he said these
things, a certain woman out of the
multitude lifted up her voice and said to
him, "Blessed is the womb that bore you,
and the breasts which nursed you!"

28 But he said, “On the contrary, blessed
are those who hear the word of God, and
keep it.”
29 When the multitudes were gathering
together to him, he began to say, “This is
an evil generation. It seeks after a sign.
No sign will be given to it but the sign of
Jonah the prophet.
30 For even as Jonah became a sign to
the Ninevites, so the Son of Man will also
be to this generation.
31 The Queen of the South will rise up in
the judgment with the men of this
generation and will condemn them, for
she came from the ends of the earth to
hear the wisdom of Solomon; and behold,
one greater than Solomon is here.
32 The men of Nineveh will stand up in
the judgment with this generation, and
will condemn it, for they repented at the
preaching of Jonah; and behold, one
greater than Jonah is here.
33 “No one, when he has lit a lamp, puts
it in a cellar or under a basket, but on a
stand, that those who come in may see the
light.
34 The lamp of the body is the eye.
Therefore when your eye is good, your
whole body is also full of light; but when it
is evil, your body also is full of darkness.
35 Therefore see whether the light that
is in you isn’t darkness.
36 If therefore your whole body is full of
light, having no part dark, it will be
wholly full of light, as when the lamp with
its bright shining gives you light.”
37 Now as he spoke, a certain Pharisee
asked him to dine with him. He went in
and sat at the table.
38 When the Pharisee saw it, he
marveled that he had not first washed
himself before dinner.
39 The Lord said to him, “Now you
Pharisees cleanse the outside of the cup
and of the platter, but your inward part is
full of extortion and wickedness.
40 You foolish ones, didn’t he who made
the outside make the inside also?
41 But give for gifts to the needy those
things which are within, and behold, all
things will be clean to you.
42 But woe to you Pharisees! For you
tithe the mint and rue and every herb, but
you bypass justice and God’s love. You
ought to have done these, and not to have
left the other undone.
43 Woe to you Pharisees! For you love
the best seats in the synagogues and the
greetings in the marketplaces.
44 Woe to you, scribes and Pharisees,
hypocrites! For you are like hidden
graves, and the men who walk over them
don’t know it.”
45 One of the lawyers answered him,
“Teacher, in saying this you insult us also.”
46 He said, “Woe to you lawyers also!
For you load men with burdens that are
difficult to carry, and you yourselves
won’t even lift one finger to help carry
those burdens.
47 Woe to you! For you build the tombs
of the prophets, and your fathers killed
them.
48 So you testify and consent to the
works of your fathers. For they killed
them, and you build their tombs.
49 Therefore also the wisdom of God
said, ‘I will send to them prophets and
apostles; and some of them they will kill
and persecute,
50 that the blood of all the prophets,
which was shed from the foundation of
the world, may be required of this
generation,
51 from the blood of Abel to the blood of
Zachariah, who perished between the
altar and the sanctuary.’ Yes, I tell you, it
will be required of this generation.
52 Woe to you lawyers! For you took
away the key of knowledge. You didn’t
enter in yourselves, and those who were
entering in, you hindered.”
53 As he said these things to them, the
scribes and the Pharisees began to be
terribly angry, and to draw many things
out of him,
54 lying in wait for him, and seeking to
catch him in something he might say, that
they might accuse him.

12

1 Meanwhile, when a multitude of many
thousands had gathered together, so

much so that they trampled on each other,
he began to tell his disciples first of all,
"Beware of the yeast of the Pharisees,
which is hypocrisy.
2 But there is nothing covered up that
will not be revealed, nor hidden that will
not be known.
3 Therefore whatever you have said in
the darkness will be heard in the light.
What you have spoken in the ear in the
inner rooms will be proclaimed on the
housetops.
4 "I tell you, my friends, don't be afraid
of those who kill the body, and after that
have no more that they can do.
5 But I will warn you whom you should
fear. Fear him who after he has killed, has
power to cast into Gehenna.† Yes, I tell
you, fear him.
6 "Aren't five sparrows sold for two
assaria coins‡? Not one of them is
forgotten by God.
7 But the very hairs of your head are all
counted. Therefore don't be afraid. You
are of more value than many sparrows.
8 "I tell you, everyone who confesses me
before men, the Son of Man will also
confess before the angels of God;
9 but he who denies me in the presence
of men will be denied in the presence of
God's angels.
10 Everyone who speaks a word against
the Son of Man will be forgiven, but those
who blaspheme against the Holy Spirit
will not be forgiven.
11 When they bring you before the
synagogues, the rulers, and the
authorities, don't be anxious how or what
you will answer or what you will say;
12 for the Holy Spirit will teach you in
that same hour what you must say."
13 One of the multitude said to him,
"Teacher, tell my brother to divide the
inheritance with me."
14 But he said to him, "Man, who made
me a judge or an arbitrator over you?"
15 He said to them, "Beware! Keep
yourselves from covetousness, for a man's
life doesn't consist of the abundance of
the things which he possesses."
16 He spoke a parable to them, saying,
"The ground of a certain rich man
produced abundantly.
17 He reasoned within himself, saying,
'What will I do, because I don't have room
to store my crops?'
18 He said, 'This is what I will do. I will
pull down my barns, build bigger ones,
and there I will store all my grain and my
goods.
19 I will tell my soul, "Soul, you have
many goods laid up for many years. Take
your ease, eat, drink, and be merry." '
20 "But God said to him, 'You foolish one,
tonight your soul is required of you. The
things which you have prepared—whose
will they be?'
21 So is he who lays up treasure for
himself, and is not rich toward God."
22 He said to his disciples, "Therefore I
tell you, don't be anxious for your life,
what you will eat, nor yet for your body,
what you will wear.
23 Life is more than food, and the body
is more than clothing.
24 Consider the ravens: they don't sow,
they don't reap, they have no warehouse
or barn, and God feeds them. How much
more valuable are you than birds!
25 Which of you by being anxious can
add a cubit§ to his height?
26 If then you aren't able to do even the
least things, why are you anxious about
the rest?
27 Consider the lilies, how they grow.
They don't toil, neither do they spin; yet I
tell you, even Solomon in all his glory was
not arrayed like one of these.
28 But if this is how God clothes the grass
in the field, which today exists and
tomorrow is cast into the oven, how much
more will he clothe you, O you of little
faith?
29 "Don't seek what you will eat or what
you will drink; neither be anxious.

† **12:5** or, Hell ‡ **12:6** An assarion was a small copper coin worth about an hour's wages for an agricultural laborer.
§ **12:25** A cubit is the length from the tip of the middle finger to the elbow on a man's arm, or about 18 inches or 46 centimeters.

30 For the nations of the world seek after
all of these things, but your Father knows
that you need these things.
31 But seek God's Kingdom, and all these
things will be added to you.
32 "Don't be afraid, little flock, for it is
your Father's good pleasure to give you
the Kingdom.
33 Sell what you have and give gifts to
the needy. Make for yourselves purses
which don't grow old, a treasure in the
heavens that doesn't fail, where no thief
approaches and no moth destroys.
34 For where your treasure is, there will
your heart be also.
35 "Let your waist be dressed and your
lamps burning.
36 Be like men watching for their lord
when he returns from the wedding feast,
that when he comes and knocks, they may
immediately open to him.
37 Blessed are those servants whom the
lord will find watching when he comes.
Most certainly I tell you that he will dress
himself, make them recline, and will
come and serve them.
38 They will be blessed if he comes in the
second or third watch and finds them so.
39 But know this, that if the master of the
house had known in what hour the thief
was coming, he would have watched and
not allowed his house to be broken into.
40 Therefore be ready also, for the Son
of Man is coming in an hour that you don't
expect him."
41 Peter said to him, "Lord, are you
telling this parable to us, or to
everybody?"
42 The Lord said, "Who then is the
faithful and wise steward, whom his lord
will set over his household, to give them
their portion of food at the right times?
43 Blessed is that servant whom his lord
will find doing so when he comes.
44 Truly I tell you that he will set him
over all that he has.
45 But if that servant says in his heart,
'My lord delays his coming,' and begins to
beat the menservants and the
maidservants, and to eat and drink and to
be drunken,
46 then the lord of that servant will
come in a day when he isn't expecting him
and in an hour that he doesn't know, and
will cut him in two, and place his portion
with the unfaithful.
47 That servant who knew his lord's will,
and didn't prepare nor do what he
wanted, will be beaten with many stripes,
48 but he who didn't know, and did
things worthy of stripes, will be beaten
with few stripes. To whomever much is
given, of him will much be required; and
to whom much was entrusted, of him
more will be asked.
49 "I came to throw fire on the earth. I
wish it were already kindled.
50 But I have a baptism to be baptized
with, and how distressed I am until it is
accomplished!
51 Do you think that I have come to give
peace in the earth? I tell you, no, but
rather division.
52 For from now on, there will be five in
one house divided, three against two, and
two against three.
53 They will be divided, father against
son, and son against father; mother
against daughter, and daughter against
her mother; mother-in-law against her
daughter-in-law, and daughter-in-law
against her mother-in-law." *
54 He said to the multitudes also, "When
you see a cloud rising from the west,
immediately you say, 'A shower is
coming,' and so it happens.
55 When a south wind blows, you say,
'There will be a scorching heat,' and it
happens.
56 You hypocrites! You know how to
interpret the appearance of the earth and
the sky, but how is it that you don't
interpret this time?
57 "Why don't you judge for yourselves
what is right?
58 For when you are going with your
adversary before the magistrate, try
diligently on the way to be released from
him, lest perhaps he drag you to the judge,
and the judge deliver you to the officer,
and the officer throw you into prison.

* **12:53** Micah 7:6

59 I tell you, you will by no means get out
of there until you have paid the very last
penny.†”

13

1 Now there were some present at the
same time who told him about the
Galileans whose blood Pilate had mixed
with their sacrifices.
2 Jesus answered them, “Do you think
that these Galileans were worse sinners
than all the other Galileans, because they
suffered such things?
3 I tell you, no, but unless you repent,
you will all perish in the same way.
4 Or those eighteen on whom the tower
in Siloam fell and killed them—do you
think that they were worse offenders than
all the men who dwell in Jerusalem?
5 I tell you, no, but, unless you repent,
you will all perish in the same way.”
6 He spoke this parable. “A certain man
had a fig tree planted in his vineyard, and
he came seeking fruit on it and found
none.
7 He said to the vine dresser, ‘Behold,
these three years I have come looking for
fruit on this fig tree, and found none. Cut
it down! Why does it waste the soil?’
8 He answered, ‘Lord, leave it alone this
year also, until I dig around it and fertilize
it.
9 If it bears fruit, fine; but if not, after
that, you can cut it down.’ ”
10 He was teaching in one of the
synagogues on the Sabbath day.
11 Behold, there was a woman who had
a spirit of infirmity eighteen years. She
was bent over and could in no way
straighten herself up.
12 When Jesus saw her, he called her
and said to her, “Woman, you are freed
from your infirmity.”
13 He laid his hands on her, and
immediately she stood up straight and
glorified God.
14 The ruler of the synagogue, being
indignant because Jesus had healed on
the Sabbath, said to the multitude, “There
are six days in which men ought to work.
Therefore come on those days and be
healed, and not on the Sabbath day!”
15 Therefore the Lord answered him,
“You hypocrites! Doesn’t each one of you
free his ox or his donkey from the stall on
the Sabbath and lead him away to water?
16 Ought not this woman, being a
daughter of Abraham whom Satan had
bound eighteen long years, be freed from
this bondage on the Sabbath day?”
17 As he said these things, all his
adversaries were disappointed; and all
the multitude rejoiced for all the glorious
things that were done by him.
18 He said, “What is God’s Kingdom like?
To what shall I compare it?
19 It is like a grain of mustard seed
which a man took and put in his own
garden. It grew and became a large tree,
and the birds of the sky live in its
branches.”
20 Again he said, “To what shall I
compare God’s Kingdom?
21 It is like yeast, which a woman took
and hid in three measures † of flour, until
it was all leavened.”
22 He went on his way through cities
and villages, teaching, and traveling on to
Jerusalem.
23 One said to him, “Lord, are they few
who are saved?”
He said to them,
24 “Strive to enter in by the narrow
door, for many, I tell you, will seek to
enter in and will not be able.
25 When once the master of the house
has risen up and has shut the door, and
you begin to stand outside and to knock at
the door, saying, ‘Lord, Lord, open to us!’
then he will answer and tell you, ‘I don’t
know you or where you come from.’
26 Then you will begin to say, ‘We ate
and drank in your presence, and you
taught in our streets.’
27 He will say, ‘I tell you, I don’t know
where you come from. Depart from me,
all you workers of iniquity.’

† **12:59** literally, lepton. A lepton is a very small brass Jewish coin worth half a Roman quadrans each, which is worth a quarter of the copper assarion. Lepta are worth less than 1% of an agricultural worker’s daily wages. † **13:21** literally, three sata. 3 sata is about 39 liters or a bit more than a bushel.

28 There will be weeping and gnashing
of teeth when you see Abraham, Isaac,
Jacob, and all the prophets in God's
Kingdom, and yourselves being thrown
outside.
29 They will come from the east, west,
north, and south, and will sit down in
God's Kingdom.
30 Behold, there are some who are last
who will be first, and there are some who
are first who will be last."
31 On that same day, some Pharisees
came, saying to him, "Get out of here and
go away, for Herod wants to kill you."
32 He said to them, "Go and tell that fox,
'Behold, I cast out demons and perform
cures today and tomorrow, and the third
day I complete my mission.
33 Nevertheless I must go on my way
today and tomorrow and the next day, for
it can't be that a prophet would perish
outside of Jerusalem.'
34 "Jerusalem, Jerusalem, you who kills
the prophets and stones those who are
sent to her! How often I wanted to gather
your children together, like a hen gathers
her own brood under her wings, and you
refused!
35 Behold, your house is left to you
desolate. I tell you, you will not see me
until you say, 'Blessed is he who comes in
the name of the Lord!' " *

14

1 When he went into the house of one of
the rulers of the Pharisees on a Sabbath to
eat bread, they were watching him.
2 Behold, a certain man who had dropsy
was in front of him.
3 Jesus, answering, spoke to the lawyers
and Pharisees, saying, "Is it lawful to heal
on the Sabbath?"
4 But they were silent.
He took him, and healed him, and let
him go.
5 He answered them, "Which of you, if
your son† or an ox fell into a well,
wouldn't immediately pull him out on a
Sabbath day?"
6 They couldn't answer him regarding
these things.
7 He spoke a parable to those who were
invited, when he noticed how they chose
the best seats, and said to them,
8 "When you are invited by anyone to a
wedding feast, don't sit in the best seat,
since perhaps someone more honorable
than you might be invited by him,
9 and he who invited both of you would
come and tell you, 'Make room for this
person.' Then you would begin, with
shame, to take the lowest place.
10 But when you are invited, go and sit
in the lowest place, so that when he who
invited you comes, he may tell you,
'Friend, move up higher.' Then you will be
honored in the presence of all who sit at
the table with you.
11 For everyone who exalts himself will
be humbled, and whoever humbles
himself will be exalted."
12 He also said to the one who had
invited him, "When you make a dinner or
a supper, don't call your friends, nor your
brothers, nor your kinsmen, nor rich
neighbors, or perhaps they might also
return the favor, and pay you back.
13 But when you make a feast, ask the
poor, the maimed, the lame, or the blind;
14 and you will be blessed, because they
don't have the resources to repay you. For
you will be repaid in the resurrection of
the righteous."
15 When one of those who sat at the
table with him heard these things, he said
to him, "Blessed is he who will feast in
God's Kingdom!"
16 But he said to him, "A certain man
made a great supper, and he invited many
people.
17 He sent out his servant at supper time
to tell those who were invited, 'Come, for
everything is ready now.'
18 They all as one began to make
excuses.
"The first said to him, 'I have bought a
field, and I must go and see it. Please have
me excused.'
19 "Another said, 'I have bought five
yoke of oxen, and I must go try them out.
Please have me excused.'

* **13:35** Psalms 118:26 † **14:5** TR reads "donkey" instead of "son"

20 “Another said, ‘I have married a wife,
and therefore I can’t come.’
21 “That servant came, and told his lord
these things. Then the master of the
house, being angry, said to his servant,
‘Go out quickly into the streets and lanes
of the city, and bring in the poor, maimed,
blind, and lame.’
22 “The servant said, ‘Lord, it is done as
you commanded, and there is still room.’
23 “The lord said to the servant, ‘Go out
into the highways and hedges, and
compel them to come in, that my house
may be filled.
24 For I tell you that none of those men
who were invited will taste of my supper.
For many are called, but few are
chosen.‡’ ”
25 Now great multitudes were going
with him. He turned and said to them,
26 “If anyone comes to me, and doesn’t
disregard§ his own father, mother, wife,
children, brothers, and sisters, yes, and
his own life also, he can’t be my disciple.
27 Whoever doesn’t bear his own cross
and come after me, can’t be my disciple.
28 For which of you, desiring to build a
tower, doesn’t first sit down and count the
cost, to see if he has enough to complete
it?
29 Or perhaps, when he has laid a
foundation and isn’t able to finish,
everyone who sees begins to mock him,
30 saying, ‘This man began to build and
wasn’t able to finish.’
31 Or what king, as he goes to encounter
another king in war, will not sit down first
and consider whether he is able with ten
thousand to meet him who comes against
him with twenty thousand?
32 Or else, while the other is yet a great
way off, he sends an envoy and asks for
conditions of peace.
33 So therefore, whoever of you who
doesn’t renounce all that he has, he can’t
be my disciple.
34 “Salt is good, but if the salt becomes
flat and tasteless, with what do you
season it?
35 It is fit neither for the soil nor for the
manure pile. It is thrown out. He who has
ears to hear, let him hear.”

15

1 Now all the tax collectors and sinners
were coming close to him to hear him.
2 The Pharisees and the scribes
murmured, saying, “This man welcomes
sinners, and eats with them.”
3 He told them this parable:
4 “Which of you men, if you had one
hundred sheep and lost one of them,
wouldn’t leave the ninety-nine in the
wilderness and go after the one that was
lost, until he found it?
5 When he has found it, he carries it on
his shoulders, rejoicing.
6 When he comes home, he calls
together his friends and his neighbors,
saying to them, ‘Rejoice with me, for I
have found my sheep which was lost!’
7 I tell you that even so there will be
more joy in heaven over one sinner who
repents, than over ninety-nine righteous
people who need no repentance.
8 “Or what woman, if she had ten
drachma† coins, if she lost one drachma
coin, wouldn’t light a lamp, sweep the
house, and seek diligently until she found
it?
9 When she has found it, she calls
together her friends and neighbors,
saying, ‘Rejoice with me, for I have found
the drachma which I had lost!’
10 Even so, I tell you, there is joy in the
presence of the angels of God over one
sinner repenting.”
11 He said, “A certain man had two sons.
12 The younger of them said to his
father, ‘Father, give me my share of your
property.’ So he divided his livelihood
between them.
13 Not many days after, the younger son
gathered all of this together and traveled
into a far country. There he wasted his
property with riotous living.
14 When he had spent all of it, there
arose a severe famine in that country, and
he began to be in need.

‡ **14:24** RP MT includes the last sentence. TR, NU, and FH MT omit: For many are called, but few are chosen. § **14:26** or, hate † **15:8** A drachma coin was worth about a days wages for an agricultural laborer.

15 He went and joined himself to one of
the citizens of that country, and he sent
him into his fields to feed pigs.
16 He wanted to fill his belly with the
pods that the pigs ate, but no one gave
him any.
17 But when he came to himself, he said,
'How many hired servants of my father's
have bread enough to spare, and I'm
dying with hunger!
18 I will get up and go to my father, and
will tell him, "Father, I have sinned
against heaven and in your sight.
19 I am no more worthy to be called
your son. Make me as one of your hired
servants." '
20 "He arose and came to his father. But
while he was still far off, his father saw
him and was moved with compassion,
and ran, fell on his neck, and kissed him.
21 The son said to him, 'Father, I have
sinned against heaven and in your sight. I
am no longer worthy to be called your
son.'
22 "But the father said to his servants,
'Bring out the best robe and put it on him.
Put a ring on his hand and sandals on his
feet.
23 Bring the fattened calf, kill it, and let's
eat and celebrate;
24 for this, my son, was dead and is alive
again. He was lost and is found.' Then
they began to celebrate.
25 "Now his elder son was in the field. As
he came near to the house, he heard
music and dancing.
26 He called one of the servants to him
and asked what was going on.
27 He said to him, 'Your brother has
come, and your father has killed the
fattened calf, because he has received him
back safe and healthy.'
28 But he was angry and would not go in.
Therefore his father came out and begged
him.
29 But he answered his father, 'Behold,
these many years I have served you, and I
never disobeyed a commandment of
yours, but you never gave me a goat, that I
might celebrate with my friends.
30 But when this your son came, who
has devoured your living with prostitutes,
you killed the fattened calf for him.'
31 "He said to him, 'Son, you are always
with me, and all that is mine is yours.
32 But it was appropriate to celebrate
and be glad, for this, your brother, was
dead, and is alive again. He was lost, and
is found.' "

16

1 He also said to his disciples, "There
was a certain rich man who had a
manager. An accusation was made to him
that this man was wasting his possessions.
2 He called him, and said to him, 'What
is this that I hear about you? Give an
accounting of your management, for you
can no longer be manager.'
3 "The manager said within himself,
'What will I do, seeing that my lord is
taking away the management position
from me? I don't have strength to dig. I
am ashamed to beg.
4 I know what I will do, so that when I
am removed from management, they may
receive me into their houses.'
5 Calling each one of his lord's debtors to
him, he said to the first, 'How much do
you owe to my lord?'
6 He said, 'A hundred batos† of oil.' He
said to him, 'Take your bill, and sit down
quickly and write fifty.'
7 Then he said to another, 'How much
do you owe?' He said, 'A hundred cors‡ of
wheat.' He said to him, 'Take your bill,
and write eighty.'
8 "His lord commended the dishonest
manager because he had done wisely, for
the children of this world are, in their
own generation, wiser than the children
of the light.
9 I tell you, make for yourselves friends
by means of unrighteous mammon, so
that when you fail, they may receive you
into the eternal tents.
10 He who is faithful in a very little is
faithful also in much. He who is dishonest
in a very little is also dishonest in much.

† **16:6** 100 batos is about 395 liters or 104 U. S. gallons.
‡ **16:7** 100 cors = about 2,110 liters or 600 bushels.

11 If therefore you have not been
faithful in the unrighteous mammon, who
will commit to your trust the true riches?
12 If you have not been faithful in that
which is another's, who will give you that
which is your own?
13 No servant can serve two masters, for
either he will hate the one and love the
other; or else he will hold to one and
despise the other. You aren't able to serve
God and Mammon."§
14 The Pharisees, who were lovers of
money, also heard all these things, and
they scoffed at him.
15 He said to them, "You are those who
justify yourselves in the sight of men, but
God knows your hearts. For that which is
exalted among men is an abomination in
the sight of God.
16 "The law and the prophets were until
John. From that time the Good News of
God's Kingdom is preached, and everyone
is forcing his way into it.
17 But it is easier for heaven and earth to
pass away than for one tiny stroke of a
pen in the law to fall.
18 "Everyone who divorces his wife and
marries another commits adultery. He
who marries one who is divorced from a
husband commits adultery.
19 "Now there was a certain rich man,
and he was clothed in purple and fine
linen, living in luxury every day.
20 A certain beggar, named Lazarus,
was taken to his gate, full of sores,
21 and desiring to be fed with the
crumbs that fell from the rich man's table.
Yes, even the dogs came and licked his
sores.
22 The beggar died, and he was carried
away by the angels to Abraham's bosom.
The rich man also died and was buried.
23 In Hades,† he lifted up his eyes, being
in torment, and saw Abraham far off, and
Lazarus at his bosom.
24 He cried and said, 'Father Abraham,
have mercy on me, and send Lazarus, that
he may dip the tip of his finger in water
and cool my tongue! For I am in anguish
in this flame.'
25 "But Abraham said, 'Son, remember
that you, in your lifetime, received your
good things, and Lazarus, in the same
way, bad things. But here he is now
comforted and you are in anguish.
26 Besides all this, between us and you
there is a great gulf fixed, that those who
want to pass from here to you are not
able, and that no one may cross over from
there to us.'
27 "He said, 'I ask you therefore, father,
that you would send him to my father's
house—
28 for I have five brothers—that he may
testify to them, so they won't also come
into this place of torment.'
29 "But Abraham said to him, 'They have
Moses and the prophets. Let them listen to
them.'
30 "He said, 'No, father Abraham, but if
one goes to them from the dead, they will
repent.'
31 "He said to him, 'If they don't listen to
Moses and the prophets, neither will they
be persuaded if one rises from the dead.' "

17

1 He said to the disciples, "It is
impossible that no occasions of stumbling
should come, but woe to him through
whom they come!
2 It would be better for him if a
millstone were hung around his neck, and
he were thrown into the sea, rather than
that he should cause one of these little
ones to stumble.
3 Be careful. If your brother sins against
you, rebuke him. If he repents, forgive
him.
4 If he sins against you seven times in
the day, and seven times returns, saying, 'I
repent,' you shall forgive him."
5 The apostles said to the Lord,
"Increase our faith."
6 The Lord said, "If you had faith like a
grain of mustard seed, you would tell this
sycamore tree, 'Be uprooted and be
planted in the sea,' and it would obey you.
7 But who is there among you, having a
servant plowing or keeping sheep, that
will say when he comes in from the field,

§ **16:13** "Mammon" refers to riches or a false god of wealth. † **16:23** or, Hell

‘Come immediately and sit down at the table’?
8 Wouldn’t he rather tell him, ‘Prepare my supper, clothe yourself properly, and serve me while I eat and drink. Afterward you shall eat and drink’?
9 Does he thank that servant because he did the things that were commanded? I think not.
10 Even so you also, when you have done all the things that are commanded you, say, ‘We are unworthy servants. We have done our duty.’ ”
11 As he was on his way to Jerusalem, he was passing along the borders of Samaria and Galilee.
12 As he entered into a certain village, ten men who were lepers met him, who stood at a distance.
13 They lifted up their voices, saying, “Jesus, Master, have mercy on us!”
14 When he saw them, he said to them, “Go and show yourselves to the priests.” As they went, they were cleansed.
15 One of them, when he saw that he was healed, turned back, glorifying God with a loud voice.
16 He fell on his face at Jesus’ feet, giving him thanks; and he was a Samaritan.
17 Jesus answered, “Weren’t the ten cleansed? But where are the nine?
18 Were there none found who returned to give glory to God, except this foreigner?”
19 Then he said to him, “Get up, and go your way. Your faith has healed you.”
20 Being asked by the Pharisees when God’s Kingdom would come, he answered them, “God’s Kingdom doesn’t come with observation;
21 neither will they say, ‘Look, here!’ or, ‘Look, there!’ for behold, God’s Kingdom is within you.”
22 He said to the disciples, “The days will come when you will desire to see one of the days of the Son of Man, and you will not see it.
23 They will tell you, ‘Look, here!’ or ‘Look, there!’ Don’t go away or follow after them,
24 for as the lightning, when it flashes out of one part under the sky, shines to another part under the sky, so will the Son of Man be in his day.
25 But first, he must suffer many things and be rejected by this generation.
26 As it was in the days of Noah, even so it will also be in the days of the Son of Man.
27 They ate, they drank, they married, and they were given in marriage until the day that Noah entered into the ship, and the flood came and destroyed them all.
28 Likewise, even as it was in the days of Lot: they ate, they drank, they bought, they sold, they planted, they built;
29 but in the day that Lot went out from Sodom, it rained fire and sulfur from the sky and destroyed them all.
30 It will be the same way in the day that the Son of Man is revealed.
31 In that day, he who will be on the housetop and his goods in the house, let him not go down to take them away. Let him who is in the field likewise not turn back.
32 Remember Lot’s wife!
33 Whoever seeks to save his life loses it, but whoever loses his life preserves it.
34 I tell you, in that night there will be two people in one bed. One will be taken and the other will be left.
35 There will be two grinding grain together. One will be taken and the other will be left.”
36 †
37 They, answering, asked him, “Where, Lord?”
He said to them, “Where the body is, there the vultures will also be gathered together.”

18

1 He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray and not give up,
2 saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn’t fear God and didn’t respect man.
3 A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

† **17:36** Some Greek manuscripts add: “Two will be in the field: the one taken, and the other left.”

4 He wouldn't for a while; but afterward
he said to himself, 'Though I neither fear
God nor respect man,
5 yet because this widow bothers me, I
will defend her, or else she will wear me
out by her continual coming.' "

6 The Lord said, "Listen to what the
unrighteous judge says.
7 Won't God avenge his chosen ones
who are crying out to him day and night,
and yet he exercises patience with them?
8 I tell you that he will avenge them
quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of
Man comes, will he find faith on the
earth?"

9 He also spoke this parable to certain
people who were convinced of their own
righteousness, and who despised all
others:
10 "Two men went up into the temple to
pray; one was a Pharisee, and the other
was a tax collector.
11 The Pharisee stood and prayed by
himself like this: 'God, I thank you that I
am not like the rest of men: extortionists,
unrighteous, adulterers, or even like this
tax collector.
12 I fast twice a week. I give tithes of all
that I get.'
13 But the tax collector, standing far
away, wouldn't even lift up his eyes to
heaven, but beat his chest, saying, 'God, be
merciful to me, a sinner!'
14 I tell you, this man went down to his
house justified rather than the other; for
everyone who exalts himself will be
humbled, but he who humbles himself
will be exalted."

15 They were also bringing their babies
to him, that he might touch them. But
when the disciples saw it, they rebuked
them.
16 Jesus summoned them, saying, "Allow
the little children to come to me, and don't
hinder them, for God's Kingdom belongs
to such as these.
17 Most certainly, I tell you, whoever
doesn't receive God's Kingdom like a little
child, he will in no way enter into it."

18 A certain ruler asked him, saying,
"Good Teacher, what shall I do to inherit
eternal life?"
19 Jesus asked him, "Why do you call me
good? No one is good, except one: God.
20 You know the commandments: 'Don't
commit adultery,' 'Don't murder,' 'Don't
steal,' 'Don't give false testimony,' 'Honor
your father and your mother.' "*
21 He said, "I have observed all these
things from my youth up."
22 When Jesus heard these things, he
said to him, "You still lack one thing. Sell
all that you have and distribute it to the
poor. Then you will have treasure in
heaven; then come, follow me."
23 But when he heard these things, he
became very sad, for he was very rich.
24 Jesus, seeing that he became very sad,
said, "How hard it is for those who have
riches to enter into God's Kingdom!
25 For it is easier for a camel to enter in
through a needle's eye than for a rich man
to enter into God's Kingdom."
26 Those who heard it said, "Then who
can be saved?"
27 But he said, "The things which are
impossible with men are possible with
God."
28 Peter said, "Look, we have left
everything and followed you."
29 He said to them, "Most certainly I tell
you, there is no one who has left house, or
wife, or brothers, or parents, or children,
for God's Kingdom's sake,
30 who will not receive many times
more in this time, and in the world to
come, eternal life."
31 He took the twelve aside and said to
them, "Behold, we are going up to
Jerusalem, and all the things that are
written through the prophets concerning
the Son of Man will be completed.
32 For he will be delivered up to the
Gentiles, will be mocked, treated
shamefully, and spit on.
33 They will scourge and kill him. On the
third day, he will rise again."
34 They understood none of these
things. This saying was hidden from

* **18:20** Exodus 20:12-16; Deuteronomy 5:16-20

them, and they didn't understand the things that were said.
35 As he came near Jericho, a certain blind man sat by the road, begging.
36 Hearing a multitude going by, he asked what this meant.
37 They told him that Jesus of Nazareth was passing by.
38 He cried out, "Jesus, you son of David, have mercy on me!"
39 Those who led the way rebuked him, that he should be quiet; but he cried out all the more, "You son of David, have mercy on me!"
40 Standing still, Jesus commanded him to be brought to him. When he had come near, he asked him,
41 "What do you want me to do?"
He said, "Lord, that I may see again."
42 Jesus said to him, "Receive your sight. Your faith has healed you."
43 Immediately he received his sight and followed him, glorifying God. All the people, when they saw it, praised God.

19

1 He entered and was passing through Jericho.
2 There was a man named Zacchaeus. He was a chief tax collector, and he was rich.
3 He was trying to see who Jesus was, and couldn't because of the crowd, because he was short.
4 He ran on ahead and climbed up into a sycamore tree to see him, for he was going to pass that way.
5 When Jesus came to the place, he looked up and saw him, and said to him, "Zacchaeus, hurry and come down, for today I must stay at your house."
6 He hurried, came down, and received him joyfully.
7 When they saw it, they all murmured, saying, "He has gone in to lodge with a man who is a sinner."
8 Zacchaeus stood and said to the Lord, "Behold, Lord, half of my goods I give to the poor. If I have wrongfully exacted anything of anyone, I restore four times as much."
9 Jesus said to him, "Today, salvation has come to this house, because he also is a son of Abraham.
10 For the Son of Man came to seek and to save that which was lost."
11 As they heard these things, he went on and told a parable, because he was near Jerusalem, and they supposed that God's Kingdom would be revealed immediately.
12 He said therefore, "A certain nobleman went into a far country to receive for himself a kingdom and to return.
13 He called ten servants of his and gave them ten mina coins, † and told them, 'Conduct business until I come.'
14 But his citizens hated him, and sent an envoy after him, saying, 'We don't want this man to reign over us.'
15 "When he had come back again, having received the kingdom, he commanded these servants, to whom he had given the money, to be called to him, that he might know what they had gained by conducting business.
16 The first came before him, saying, 'Lord, your mina has made ten more minas.'
17 "He said to him, 'Well done, you good servant! Because you were found faithful with very little, you shall have authority over ten cities.'
18 "The second came, saying, 'Your mina, Lord, has made five minas.'
19 "So he said to him, 'And you are to be over five cities.'
20 Another came, saying, 'Lord, behold, your mina, which I kept laid away in a handkerchief,
21 for I feared you, because you are an exacting man. You take up that which you didn't lay down, and reap that which you didn't sow.'
22 "He said to him, 'Out of your own mouth I will judge you, you wicked servant! You knew that I am an exacting man, taking up that which I didn't lay

† **19:13** 10 minas was more than 3 years' wages for an agricultural laborer.

down and reaping that which I didn't sow.
23 Then why didn't you deposit my
money in the bank, and at my coming, I
might have earned interest on it?'
24 He said to those who stood by, 'Take
the mina away from him and give it to
him who has the ten minas.'
25 "They said to him, 'Lord, he has ten
minas!'
26 'For I tell you that to everyone who
has, will more be given; but from him
who doesn't have, even that which he has
will be taken away from him.
27 But bring those enemies of mine who
didn't want me to reign over them here,
and kill them before me.' "
28 Having said these things, he went on
ahead, going up to Jerusalem.
29 When he came near to Bethsphage‡
and Bethany, at the mountain that is
called Olivet, he sent two of his disciples,
30 saying, "Go your way into the village
on the other side, in which, as you enter,
you will find a colt tied, which no man has
ever sat upon. Untie it and bring it.
31 If anyone asks you, 'Why are you
untying it?' say to him: 'The Lord needs
it.' "
32 Those who were sent went away and
found things just as he had told them.
33 As they were untying the colt, its
owners said to them, "Why are you
untying the colt?"
34 They said, "The Lord needs it."
35 Then they brought it to Jesus. They
threw their cloaks on the colt and sat
Jesus on them.
36 As he went, they spread their cloaks
on the road.
37 As he was now getting near, at the
descent of the Mount of Olives, the whole
multitude of the disciples began to rejoice
and praise God with a loud voice for all
the mighty works which they had seen,
38 saying, "Blessed is the King who
comes in the name of the Lord!* Peace in
heaven, and glory in the highest!"
39 Some of the Pharisees from the
multitude said to him, "Teacher, rebuke
your disciples!"
40 He answered them, "I tell you that if
these were silent, the stones would cry
out."
41 When he came near, he saw the city
and wept over it,
42 saying, "If you, even you, had known
today the things which belong to your
peace! But now, they are hidden from
your eyes.
43 For the days will come on you when
your enemies will throw up a barricade
against you, surround you, hem you in on
every side,
44 and will dash you and your children
within you to the ground. They will not
leave in you one stone on another,
because you didn't know the time of your
visitation."
45 He entered into the temple and began
to drive out those who bought and sold in
it,
46 saying to them, "It is written, 'My
house is a house of prayer,' * but you have
made it a 'den of robbers'!" *
47 He was teaching daily in the temple,
but the chief priests, the scribes, and the
leading men among the people sought to
destroy him.
48 They couldn't find what they might
do, for all the people hung on to every
word that he said.

20

1 On one of those days, as he was
teaching the people in the temple and
preaching the Good News, the† priests and
scribes came to him with the elders.
2 They asked him, "Tell us: by what
authority do you do these things? Or who
is giving you this authority?"
3 He answered them, "I also will ask you
one question. Tell me:
4 the baptism of John, was it from
heaven, or from men?"
5 They reasoned with themselves,
saying, "If we say, 'From heaven,' he will
say, 'Why didn't you believe him?'

‡ **19:29** TR, NU read "Bethpage" instead of "Bethsphage"
* **19:38** Psalms 118:26 * **19:46** Isaiah 56:7 * **19:46**
Jeremiah 7:11 † **20:1** TR adds "chief"

6 But if we say, ‘From men,’ all the
people will stone us, for they are
persuaded that John was a prophet.”
7 They answered that they didn’t know
where it was from.
8 Jesus said to them, “Neither will I tell
you by what authority I do these things.”
9 He began to tell the people this
parable: “A ‡ man planted a vineyard and
rented it out to some farmers, and went
into another country for a long time.
10 At the proper season, he sent a
servant to the farmers to collect his share
of the fruit of the vineyard. But the
farmers beat him and sent him away
empty.
11 He sent yet another servant, and they
also beat him and treated him shamefully,
and sent him away empty.
12 He sent yet a third, and they also
wounded him and threw him out.
13 The lord of the vineyard said, ‘What
shall I do? I will send my beloved son. It
may be that seeing him, they will respect
him.’
14 “But when the farmers saw him, they
reasoned among themselves, saying, ‘This
is the heir. Come, let’s kill him, that the
inheritance may be ours.’
15 Then they threw him out of the
vineyard and killed him. What therefore
will the lord of the vineyard do to them?
16 He will come and destroy these
farmers, and will give the vineyard to
others.”
When they heard that, they said, “May
that never be!”
17 But he looked at them and said, “Then
what is this that is written,
‘The stone which the builders rejected
was made the chief cornerstone’?*
18 Everyone who falls on that stone will be
broken to pieces,
but it will crush whomever it falls on
to dust.”
19 The chief priests and the scribes
sought to lay hands on him that very hour,
but they feared the people—for they knew
he had spoken this parable against them.
20 They watched him and sent out spies,
who pretended to be righteous, that they
might trap him in something he said, so as
to deliver him up to the power and
authority of the governor.
21 They asked him, “Teacher, we know
that you say and teach what is right, and
aren’t partial to anyone, but truly teach
the way of God.
22 Is it lawful for us to pay taxes to
Caesar, or not?”
23 But he perceived their craftiness, and
said to them, “Why do you test me?
24 Show me a denarius. Whose image
and inscription are on it?”
They answered, “Caesar’s.”
25 He said to them, “Then give to Caesar
the things that are Caesar’s, and to God
the things that are God’s.”
26 They weren’t able to trap him in his
words before the people. They marveled
at his answer and were silent.
27 Some of the Sadducees came to him,
those who deny that there is a
resurrection.
28 They asked him, “Teacher, Moses
wrote to us that if a man’s brother dies
having a wife, and he is childless, his
brother should take the wife and raise up
children for his brother.
29 There were therefore seven brothers.
The first took a wife, and died childless.
30 The second took her as wife, and he
died childless.
31 The third took her, and likewise the
seven all left no children, and died.
32 Afterward the woman also died.
33 Therefore in the resurrection whose
wife of them will she be? For the seven
had her as a wife.”
34 Jesus said to them, “The children of
this age marry and are given in marriage.
35 But those who are considered worthy
to attain to that age and the resurrection
from the dead neither marry nor are
given in marriage.
36 For they can’t die any more, for they
are like the angels and are children of
God, being children of the resurrection.
37 But that the dead are raised, even
Moses showed at the bush, when he called

‡ **20:9** NU (in brackets) and TR add “certain” * **20:17** Psalms 118:22 * **20:37** Exodus 3:6

the Lord ‘The God of Abraham, the God of
Isaac, and the God of Jacob.’ *
38 Now he is not the God of the dead, but
of the living, for all are alive to him.”
39 Some of the scribes answered,
“Teacher, you speak well.”
40 They didn’t dare to ask him any more
questions.
41 He said to them, “Why do they say
that the Christ is David’s son?
42 David himself says in the book of
Psalms,
‘The Lord said to my Lord,
“Sit at my right hand,
43 until I make your enemies the
footstool of your feet.” ’ *
44 “David therefore calls him Lord, so
how is he his son?”
45 In the hearing of all the people, he
said to his disciples,
46 “Beware of those scribes who like to
walk in long robes, and love greetings in
the marketplaces, the best seats in the
synagogues, and the best places at feasts;
47 who devour widows’ houses, and for
a pretense make long prayers. These will
receive greater condemnation.”

21

1 He looked up and saw the rich people
who were putting their gifts into the
treasury.
2 He saw a certain poor widow casting
in two small brass coins.†
3 He said, “Truly I tell you, this poor
widow put in more than all of them,
4 for all these put in gifts for God from
their abundance, but she, out of her
poverty, put in all that she had to live on.”
5 As some were talking about the temple
and how it was decorated with beautiful
stones and gifts, he said,
6 “As for these things which you see, the
days will come in which there will not be
left here one stone on another that will
not be thrown down.”
7 They asked him, “Teacher, so when
will these things be? What is the sign that
these things are about to happen?”
8 He said, “Watch out that you don’t get
led astray, for many will come in my
name, saying, ‘I am he‡,’ and, ‘The time is
at hand.’ Therefore don’t follow them.
9 When you hear of wars and
disturbances, don’t be terrified, for these
things must happen first, but the end
won’t come immediately.”
10 Then he said to them, “Nation will
rise against nation, and kingdom against
kingdom.
11 There will be great earthquakes,
famines, and plagues in various places.
There will be terrors and great signs from
heaven.
12 But before all these things, they will
lay their hands on you and will persecute
you, delivering you up to synagogues and
prisons, bringing you before kings and
governors for my name’s sake.
13 It will turn out as a testimony for you.
14 Settle it therefore in your hearts not
to meditate beforehand how to answer,
15 for I will give you a mouth and
wisdom which all your adversaries will
not be able to withstand or to contradict.
16 You will be handed over even by
parents, brothers, relatives, and friends.
They will cause some of you to be put to
death.
17 You will be hated by all men for my
name’s sake.
18 And not a hair of your head will
perish.
19 “By your endurance you will win
your lives.
20 “But when you see Jerusalem
surrounded by armies, then know that its
desolation is at hand.
21 Then let those who are in Judea flee to
the mountains. Let those who are in the
middle of her depart. Let those who are in
the country not enter therein.
22 For these are days of vengeance, that
all things which are written may be
fulfilled.
23 Woe to those who are pregnant and to
those who nurse infants in those days! For
there will be great distress in the land and
wrath to this people.

* **20:43** Psalms 110:1 † **21:2** literally, “two lepta.” 2 lepta was about 1% of a day’s wages for an agricultural laborer.
‡ **21:8** or, I AM

24 They will fall by the edge of the
sword, and will be led captive into all the
nations. Jerusalem will be trampled down
by the Gentiles until the times of the
Gentiles are fulfilled.
25 "There will be signs in the sun, moon,
and stars; and on the earth anxiety of
nations, in perplexity for the roaring of
the sea and the waves;
26 men fainting for fear and for
expectation of the things which are
coming on the world, for the powers of
the heavens will be shaken.
27 Then they will see the Son of Man
coming in a cloud with power and great
glory.
28 But when these things begin to
happen, look up and lift up your heads,
because your redemption is near."
29 He told them a parable. "See the fig
tree and all the trees.
30 When they are already budding, you
see it and know by your own selves that
the summer is already near.
31 Even so you also, when you see these
things happening, know that God's
Kingdom is near.
32 Most certainly I tell you, this
generation will not pass away until all
things are accomplished.
33 Heaven and earth will pass away, but
my words will by no means pass away.
34 "So be careful, or your hearts will be
loaded down with carousing,
drunkenness, and cares of this life, and
that day will come on you suddenly.
35 For it will come like a snare on all
those who dwell on the surface of all the
earth.
36 Therefore be watchful all the time,
praying that you may be counted worthy
to escape all these things that will happen,
and to stand before the Son of Man."
37 Every day Jesus was teaching in the
temple, and every night he would go out
and spend the night on the mountain that
is called Olivet.
38 All the people came early in the
morning to him in the temple to hear him.

22

1 Now the feast of unleavened bread,
which is called the Passover, was
approaching.
2 The chief priests and the scribes
sought how they might put him to death,
for they feared the people.
3 Satan entered into Judas, who was also
called Iscariot, who was counted with the
twelve.
4 He went away and talked with the
chief priests and captains about how he
might deliver him to them.
5 They were glad, and agreed to give
him money.
6 He consented and sought an
opportunity to deliver him to them in the
absence of the multitude.
7 The day of unleavened bread came, on
which the Passover must be sacrificed.
8 Jesus sent Peter and John, saying, "Go
and prepare the Passover for us, that we
may eat."
9 They said to him, "Where do you want
us to prepare?"
10 He said to them, "Behold, when you
have entered into the city, a man carrying
a pitcher of water will meet you. Follow
him into the house which he enters.
11 Tell the master of the house, 'The
Teacher says to you, "Where is the guest
room, where I may eat the Passover with
my disciples?" '
12 He will show you a large, furnished
upper room. Make preparations there."
13 They went, found things as Jesus had
told them, and they prepared the
Passover.
14 When the hour had come, he sat
down with the twelve apostles.
15 He said to them, "I have earnestly
desired to eat this Passover with you
before I suffer,
16 for I tell you, I will no longer by any
means eat of it until it is fulfilled in God's
Kingdom."
17 He received a cup, and when he had
given thanks, he said, "Take this and share
it among yourselves,
18 for I tell you, I will not drink at all
again from the fruit of the vine, until
God's Kingdom comes."
19 He took bread, and when he had
given thanks, he broke and gave it to

them, saying, “This is my body which is
given for you. Do this in memory of me.”
20 Likewise, he took the cup after
supper, saying, “This cup is the new
covenant in my blood, which is poured
out for you.
21 But behold, the hand of him who
betrays me is with me on the table.
22 The Son of Man indeed goes as it has
been determined, but woe to that man
through whom he is betrayed!”
23 They began to question among
themselves which of them it was who
would do this thing.
24 A dispute also arose among them,
which of them was considered to be
greatest.
25 He said to them, “The kings of the
nations lord it over them, and those who
have authority over them are called
‘benefactors.’
26 But not so with you. Rather, the one
who is greater among you, let him become
as the younger, and one who is governing,
as one who serves.
27 For who is greater, one who sits at the
table, or one who serves? Isn’t it he who
sits at the table? But I am among you as
one who serves.
28 “But you are those who have
continued with me in my trials.
29 I confer on you a kingdom, even as
my Father conferred on me,
30 that you may eat and drink at my
table in my Kingdom. You will sit on
thrones, judging the twelve tribes of
Israel.”
31 The Lord said, “Simon, Simon, behold,
Satan asked to have all of you, that he
might sift you as wheat,
32 but I prayed for you, that your faith
wouldn’t fail. You, when once you have
turned again, establish your brothers.”†
33 He said to him, “Lord, I am ready to go
with you both to prison and to death!”
34 He said, “I tell you, Peter, the rooster
will by no means crow today until you
deny that you know me three times.”
35 He said to them, “When I sent you out
without purse, bag, and sandals, did you
lack anything?”
They said, “Nothing.”
36 Then he said to them, “But now,
whoever has a purse, let him take it, and
likewise a bag. Whoever has none, let him
sell his cloak, and buy a sword.
37 For I tell you that this which is written
must still be fulfilled in me: ‘He was
counted with transgressors.’* For that
which concerns me is being fulfilled.”
38 They said, “Lord, behold, here are two
swords.”
He said to them, “That is enough.”
39 He came out and went, as his custom
was, to the Mount of Olives. His disciples
also followed him.
40 When he was at the place, he said to
them, “Pray that you don’t enter into
temptation.”
41 He was withdrawn from them about
a stone’s throw, and he knelt down and
prayed,
42 saying, “Father, if you are willing,
remove this cup from me. Nevertheless,
not my will, but yours, be done.”
43 An angel from heaven appeared to
him, strengthening him.
44 Being in agony, he prayed more
earnestly. His sweat became like great
drops of blood falling down on the
ground.
45 When he rose up from his prayer, he
came to the disciples and found them
sleeping because of grief,
46 and said to them, “Why do you sleep?
Rise and pray that you may not enter into
temptation.”
47 While he was still speaking, a crowd
appeared. He who was called Judas, one
of the twelve, was leading them. He came
near to Jesus to kiss him.
48 But Jesus said to him, “Judas, do you
betray the Son of Man with a kiss?”
49 When those who were around him
saw what was about to happen, they said
to him, “Lord, shall we strike with the
sword?”

† **22:32** The word for “brothers” here may be also correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.” * **22:37** Isaiah 53:12

50 A certain one of them struck the
servant of the high priest, and cut off his
right ear.
51 But Jesus answered, "Let me at least
do this"—and he touched his ear and
healed him.
52 Jesus said to the chief priests, captains
of the temple, and elders, who had come
against him, "Have you come out as
against a robber, with swords and clubs?
53 When I was with you in the temple
daily, you didn't stretch out your hands
against me. But this is your hour, and the
power of darkness."
54 They seized him and led him away,
and brought him into the high priest's
house. But Peter followed from a distance.
55 When they had kindled a fire in the
middle of the courtyard and had sat down
together, Peter sat among them.
56 A certain servant girl saw him as he
sat in the light, and looking intently at
him, said, "This man also was with him."
57 He denied Jesus, saying, "Woman, I
don't know him."
58 After a little while someone else saw
him and said, "You also are one of them!"
But Peter answered, "Man, I am not!"
59 After about one hour passed, another
confidently affirmed, saying, "Truly this
man also was with him, for he is a
Galilean!"
60 But Peter said, "Man, I don't know
what you are talking about!"
Immediately, while he was still speaking,
a rooster crowed.
61 The Lord turned and looked at Peter.
Then Peter remembered the Lord's word,
how he said to him, "Before the rooster
crows you will deny me three times."
62 He went out, and wept bitterly.
63 The men who held Jesus mocked him
and beat him.
64 Having blindfolded him, they struck
him on the face and asked him,
"Prophesy! Who is the one who struck
you?"
65 They spoke many other things against
him, insulting him.
66 As soon as it was day, the assembly of
the elders of the people were gathered
together, both chief priests and scribes,
and they led him away into their council,
saying,
67 "If you are the Christ, tell us."
But he said to them, "If I tell you, you
won't believe,
68 and if I ask, you will in no way answer
me or let me go.
69 From now on, the Son of Man will be
seated at the right hand of the power of
God."
70 They all said, "Are you then the Son of
God?"
He said to them, "You say it, because I
am."
71 They said, "Why do we need any more
witness? For we ourselves have heard
from his own mouth!"

23

1 The whole company of them rose up
and brought him before Pilate.
2 They began to accuse him, saying, "We
found this man perverting the nation,
forbidding paying taxes to Caesar, and
saying that he himself is Christ, a king."
3 Pilate asked him, "Are you the King of
the Jews?"
He answered him, "So you say."
4 Pilate said to the chief priests and the
multitudes, "I find no basis for a charge
against this man."
5 But they insisted, saying, "He stirs up
the people, teaching throughout all Judea,
beginning from Galilee even to this place."
6 But when Pilate heard Galilee
mentioned, he asked if the man was a
Galilean.
7 When he found out that he was in
Herod's jurisdiction, he sent him to
Herod, who was also in Jerusalem during
those days.
8 Now when Herod saw Jesus, he was
exceedingly glad, for he had wanted to see
him for a long time, because he had heard
many things about him. He hoped to see
some miracle done by him.
9 He questioned him with many words,
but he gave no answers.
10 The chief priests and the scribes
stood, vehemently accusing him.
11 Herod with his soldiers humiliated
him and mocked him. Dressing him in

luxurious clothing, they sent him back to Pilate.
12 Herod and Pilate became friends with each other that very day, for before that they were enemies with each other.
13 Pilate called together the chief priests, the rulers, and the people,
14 and said to them, “You brought this man to me as one that perverts the people, and behold, having examined him before you, I found no basis for a charge against this man concerning those things of which you accuse him.
15 Neither has Herod, for I sent you to him, and see, nothing worthy of death has been done by him.
16 I will therefore chastise him and release him.”
17 Now he had to release one prisoner to them at the feast.†
18 But they all cried out together, saying, “Away with this man! Release to us Barabbas!”—
19 one who was thrown into prison for a certain revolt in the city, and for murder.
20 Then Pilate spoke to them again, wanting to release Jesus,
21 but they shouted, saying, “Crucify! Crucify him!”
22 He said to them the third time, “Why? What evil has this man done? I have found no capital crime in him. I will therefore chastise him and release him.”
23 But they were urgent with loud voices, asking that he might be crucified. Their voices and the voices of the chief priests prevailed.
24 Pilate decreed that what they asked for should be done.
25 He released him who had been thrown into prison for insurrection and murder, for whom they asked, but he delivered Jesus up to their will.
26 When they led him away, they grabbed one Simon of Cyrene, coming from the country, and laid the cross on him to carry it after Jesus.
27 A great multitude of the people followed him, including women who also mourned and lamented him.
28 But Jesus, turning to them, said, “Daughters of Jerusalem, don’t weep for me, but weep for yourselves and for your children.
29 For behold, the days are coming in which they will say, ‘Blessed are the barren, the wombs that never bore, and the breasts that never nursed.’
30 Then they will begin to tell the mountains, ‘Fall on us!’ and tell the hills, ‘Cover us.’*
31 For if they do these things in the green tree, what will be done in the dry?”
32 There were also others, two criminals, led with him to be put to death.
33 When they came to the place that is called “The Skull”, they crucified him there with the criminals, one on the right and the other on the left.
34 Jesus said, “Father, forgive them, for they don’t know what they are doing.”
Dividing his garments among them, they cast lots.
35 The people stood watching. The rulers with them also scoffed at him, saying, “He saved others. Let him save himself, if this is the Christ of God, his chosen one!”
36 The soldiers also mocked him, coming to him and offering him vinegar,
37 and saying, “If you are the King of the Jews, save yourself!”
38 An inscription was also written over him in letters of Greek, Latin, and Hebrew: “THIS IS THE KING OF THE JEWS.”
39 One of the criminals who was hanged insulted him, saying, “If you are the Christ, save yourself and us!”
40 But the other answered, and rebuking him said, “Don’t you even fear God, seeing you are under the same condemnation?
41 And we indeed justly, for we receive the due reward for our deeds, but this man has done nothing wrong.”
42 He said to Jesus, “Lord, remember me when you come into your Kingdom.”
43 Jesus said to him, “Assuredly I tell you, today you will be with me in Paradise.”

† **23:17** NU omits verse 17. * **23:30** Hosea 10:8

44 It was now about the sixth hour,‡ and
darkness came over the whole land until
the ninth hour.§
45 The sun was darkened, and the veil of
the temple was torn in two.
46 Jesus, crying with a loud voice, said,
"Father, into your hands I commit my
spirit!" Having said this, he breathed his
last.
47 When the centurion saw what was
done, he glorified God, saying, "Certainly
this was a righteous man."
48 All the multitudes that came together
to see this, when they saw the things that
were done, returned home beating their
chests.
49 All his acquaintances and the women
who followed with him from Galilee stood
at a distance, watching these things.
50 Behold, there was a man named
Joseph, who was a member of the council,
a good and righteous man
51 (he had not consented to their
counsel and deed), from Arimathaea, a
city of the Jews, who was also waiting for
God's Kingdom.
52 This man went to Pilate, and asked for
Jesus' body.
53 He took it down and wrapped it in a
linen cloth, and laid him in a tomb that
was cut in stone, where no one had ever
been laid.
54 It was the day of the Preparation, and
the Sabbath was drawing near.
55 The women who had come with him
out of Galilee followed after, and saw the
tomb and how his body was laid.
56 They returned and prepared spices
and ointments. On the Sabbath they
rested according to the commandment.

24

1 But on the first day of the week, at
early dawn, they and some others came to
the tomb, bringing the spices which they
had prepared.
2 They found the stone rolled away from
the tomb.
3 They entered in, and didn't find the
Lord Jesus' body.
4 While they were greatly perplexed
about this, behold, two men stood by them
in dazzling clothing.
5 Becoming terrified, they bowed their
faces down to the earth.
The men said to them, "Why do you
seek the living among the dead?
6 He isn't here, but is risen. Remember
what he told you when he was still in
Galilee,
7 saying that the Son of Man must be
delivered up into the hands of sinful men
and be crucified, and the third day rise
again?"
8 They remembered his words,
9 returned from the tomb, and told all
these things to the eleven and to all the
rest.
10 Now they were Mary Magdalene,
Joanna, and Mary the mother of James.
The other women with them told these
things to the apostles.
11 These words seemed to them to be
nonsense, and they didn't believe them.
12 But Peter got up and ran to the tomb.
Stooping and looking in, he saw the strips
of linen lying by themselves, and he
departed to his home, wondering what
had happened.
13 Behold, two of them were going that
very day to a village named Emmaus,
which was sixty stadia† from Jerusalem.
14 They talked with each other about all
of these things which had happened.
15 While they talked and questioned
together, Jesus himself came near, and
went with them.
16 But their eyes were kept from
recognizing him.
17 He said to them, "What are you
talking about as you walk, and are sad?"
18 One of them, named Cleopas,
answered him, "Are you the only stranger
in Jerusalem who doesn't know the things
which have happened there in these
days?"
19 He said to them, "What things?"
They said to him, "The things
concerning Jesus the Nazarene, who was

‡ **23:44** Time was counted from sunrise, so the sixth hour was about noon. § **23:44** 3:00 p.m. † **24:13** 60 stadia = about 11 kilometers or about 7 miles.

a prophet mighty in deed and word
before God and all the people;
20 and how the chief priests and our
rulers delivered him up to be condemned
to death, and crucified him.
21 But we were hoping that it was he
who would redeem Israel. Yes, and
besides all this, it is now the third day
since these things happened.
22 Also, certain women of our company
amazed us, having arrived early at the
tomb;
23 and when they didn't find his body,
they came saying that they had also seen a
vision of angels, who said that he was
alive.
24 Some of us went to the tomb and
found it just like the women had said, but
they didn't see him."
25 He said to them, "Foolish people, and
slow of heart to believe in all that the
prophets have spoken!
26 Didn't the Christ have to suffer these
things and to enter into his glory?"
27 Beginning from Moses and from all
the prophets, he explained to them in all
the Scriptures the things concerning
himself.
28 They came near to the village where
they were going, and he acted like he
would go further.
29 They urged him, saying, "Stay with us,
for it is almost evening, and the day is
almost over."
He went in to stay with them.
30 When he had sat down at the table
with them, he took the bread and gave
thanks. Breaking it, he gave it to them.
31 Their eyes were opened and they
recognized him; then he vanished out of
their sight.
32 They said to one another, "Weren't
our hearts burning within us while he
spoke to us along the way, and while he
opened the Scriptures to us?"
33 They rose up that very hour, returned
to Jerusalem, and found the eleven
gathered together, and those who were
with them,
34 saying, "The Lord is risen indeed, and
has appeared to Simon!"
35 They related the things that
happened along the way, and how he was
recognized by them in the breaking of the
bread.
36 As they said these things, Jesus
himself stood among them, and said to
them, "Peace be to you."
37 But they were terrified and filled with
fear, and supposed that they had seen a
spirit.
38 He said to them, "Why are you
troubled? Why do doubts arise in your
hearts?
39 See my hands and my feet, that it is
truly me. Touch me and see, for a spirit
doesn't have flesh and bones, as you see
that I have."
40 When he had said this, he showed
them his hands and his feet.
41 While they still didn't believe for joy,
and wondered, he said to them, "Do you
have anything here to eat?"
42 They gave him a piece of a broiled
fish and some honeycomb.
43 He took them, and ate in front of
them.
44 He said to them, "This is what I told
you while I was still with you, that all
things which are written in the law of
Moses, the prophets, and the psalms
concerning me must be fulfilled."
45 Then he opened their minds, that
they might understand the Scriptures.
46 He said to them, "Thus it is written,
and thus it was necessary for the Christ to
suffer and to rise from the dead the third
day,
47 and that repentance and remission of
sins should be preached in his name to all
the nations, beginning at Jerusalem.
48 You are witnesses of these things.
49 Behold, I send out the promise of my
Father on you. But wait in the city of
Jerusalem until you are clothed with
power from on high."
50 He led them out as far as Bethany, and
he lifted up his hands and blessed them.
51 While he blessed them, he withdrew
from them and was carried up into
heaven.
52 They worshiped him and returned to
Jerusalem with great joy,

53 and were continually in the temple,
praising and blessing God. Amen.

The Good News According to John

1 In the beginning was the Word, and
the Word was with God, and the Word
was God.
2 The same was in the beginning with
God.
3 All things were made through him.
Without him, nothing was made that has
been made.
4 In him was life, and the life was the
light of men.
5 The light shines in the darkness, and
the darkness hasn't overcome† it.
6 There came a man sent from God,
whose name was John.
7 The same came as a witness, that he
might testify about the light, that all might
believe through him.
8 He was not the light, but was sent that
he might testify about the light.
9 The true light that enlightens everyone
was coming into the world.
10 He was in the world, and the world
was made through him, and the world
didn't recognize him.
11 He came to his own, and those who
were his own didn't receive him.
12 But as many as received him, to them
he gave the right to become God's
children, to those who believe in his
name:
13 who were born, not of blood, nor of
the will of the flesh, nor of the will of man,
but of God.
14 The Word became flesh and lived
among us. We saw his glory, such glory as
of the only born‡ Son of the Father, full of
grace and truth.
15 John testified about him. He cried out,
saying, "This was he of whom I said, 'He
who comes after me has surpassed me,
for he was before me.' "
16 From his fullness we all received
grace upon grace.
17 For the law was given through Moses.
Grace and truth were realized through
Jesus Christ.§
18 No one has seen God at any time. The
only born† Son,‡ who is in the bosom of
the Father, has declared him.
19 This is John's testimony, when the
Jews sent priests and Levites from
Jerusalem to ask him, "Who are you?"
20 He declared, and didn't deny, but he
declared, "I am not the Christ."
21 They asked him, "What then? Are you
Elijah?"
He said, "I am not."
"Are you the prophet?"
He answered, "No."
22 They said therefore to him, "Who are
you? Give us an answer to take back to
those who sent us. What do you say about
yourself?"
23 He said, "I am the voice of one crying
in the wilderness, 'Make straight the way
of the Lord,'* as Isaiah the prophet said."
24 The ones who had been sent were
from the Pharisees.
25 They asked him, "Why then do you
baptize if you are not the Christ, nor
Elijah, nor the prophet?"
26 John answered them, "I baptize in
water, but among you stands one whom
you don't know.
27 He is the one who comes after me,
who is preferred before me, whose sandal
strap I'm not worthy to loosen."
28 These things were done in Bethany
beyond the Jordan, where John was
baptizing.
29 The next day, he saw Jesus coming to
him, and said, "Behold,§ the Lamb of God,
who takes away the sin of the world!
30 This is he of whom I said, 'After me
comes a man who is preferred before me,
for he was before me.'

† **1:5** The word translated "overcome" (κατέλαβεν) can also be translated "comprehended." It refers to getting a grip on an enemy to defeat him. ‡ **1:14** The phrase "only born" is from the Greek word "μονογενους", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only". § **1:17** "Christ" means "Anointed One". † **1:18** The phrase "only born" is from the Greek word "μονογενη", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only". ‡ **1:18** NU reads "God" * **1:23** Isaiah 40:3 § **1:29** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

31 I didn't know him, but for this reason
I came baptizing in water, that he would
be revealed to Israel."
32 John testified, saying, "I have seen the
Spirit descending like a dove out of
heaven, and it remained on him.
33 I didn't recognize him, but he who
sent me to baptize in water said to me, 'On
whomever you will see the Spirit
descending and remaining on him is he
who baptizes in the Holy Spirit.'
34 I have seen and have testified that
this is the Son of God."
35 Again, the next day, John was
standing with two of his disciples,
36 and he looked at Jesus as he walked,
and said, "Behold, the Lamb of God!"
37 The two disciples heard him speak,
and they followed Jesus.
38 Jesus turned and saw them following,
and said to them, "What are you looking
for?"
They said to him, "Rabbi" (which is to
say, being interpreted, Teacher), "where
are you staying?"
39 He said to them, "Come and see."
They came and saw where he was
staying, and they stayed with him that
day. It was about the tenth hour.†
40 One of the two who heard John and
followed him was Andrew, Simon Peter's
brother.
41 He first found his own brother,
Simon, and said to him, "We have found
the Messiah!" (which is, being
interpreted, Christ‡).
42 He brought him to Jesus. Jesus looked
at him and said, "You are Simon the son of
Jonah. You shall be called Cephas" (which
is by interpretation, Peter).§
43 On the next day, he was determined
to go out into Galilee, and he found Philip.
Jesus said to him, "Follow me."
44 Now Philip was from Bethsaida, the
city of Andrew and Peter.
45 Philip found Nathanael, and said to
him, "We have found him of whom Moses
in the law and also the prophets, wrote:
Jesus of Nazareth, the son of Joseph."
46 Nathanael said to him, "Can any good
thing come out of Nazareth?"
Philip said to him, "Come and see."
47 Jesus saw Nathanael coming to him,
and said about him, "Behold, an Israelite
indeed, in whom is no deceit!"
48 Nathanael said to him, "How do you
know me?"
Jesus answered him, "Before Philip
called you, when you were under the fig
tree, I saw you."
49 Nathanael answered him, "Rabbi, you
are the Son of God! You are King of Israel!"
50 Jesus answered him, "Because I told
you, 'I saw you underneath the fig tree,' do
you believe? You will see greater things
than these!"
51 He said to him, "Most certainly, I tell
you all, hereafter you will see heaven
opened, and the angels of God ascending
and descending on the Son of Man."

2

1 The third day, there was a wedding in
Cana of Galilee. Jesus' mother was there.
2 Jesus also was invited, with his
disciples, to the wedding.
3 When the wine ran out, Jesus' mother
said to him, "They have no wine."
4 Jesus said to her, "Woman, what does
that have to do with you and me? My hour
has not yet come."
5 His mother said to the servants,
"Whatever he says to you, do it."
6 Now there were six water pots of stone
set there after the Jews' way of purifying,
containing two or three metretes† apiece.
7 Jesus said to them, "Fill the water pots
with water." So they filled them up to the
brim.
8 He said to them, "Now draw some out,
and take it to the ruler of the feast." So
they took it.
9 When the ruler of the feast tasted the
water now become wine, and didn't know
where it came from (but the servants who
had drawn the water knew), the ruler of
the feast called the bridegroom

† **1:39** 4:00 p.m. ‡ **1:41** "Messiah" (Hebrew) and "Christ" (Greek) both mean "Anointed One". § **1:42** "Cephas" (Aramaic) and "Peter" (Greek) both mean "Rock". † **2:6** 2 to 3 metretes is about 20 to 30 U. S. Gallons, or 75 to 115 liters.

10 and said to him, “Everyone serves the
good wine first, and when the guests have
drunk freely, then that which is worse.
You have kept the good wine until now!”
11 This beginning of his signs Jesus did
in Cana of Galilee, and revealed his glory;
and his disciples believed in him.
12 After this, he went down to
Capernaum, he, and his mother, his
brothers, and his disciples; and they
stayed there a few days.
13 The Passover of the Jews was at hand,
and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.
14 He found in the temple those who
sold oxen, sheep, and doves, and the
changers of money sitting.
15 He made a whip of cords and drove
all out of the temple, both the sheep and
the oxen; and he poured out the changers’
money and overthrew their tables.
16 To those who sold the doves, he said,
“Take these things out of here! Don’t make
my Father’s house a marketplace!”
17 His disciples remembered that it was
written, “Zeal for your house will eat me
up.”*
18 The Jews therefore answered him,
“What sign do you show us, seeing that
you do these things?”
19 Jesus answered them, “Destroy this
temple, and in three days I will raise it
up.”
20 The Jews therefore said, “It took
forty-six years to build this temple! Will
you raise it up in three days?”
21 But he spoke of the temple of his body.
22 When therefore he was raised from
the dead, his disciples remembered that
he said this, and they believed the
Scripture and the word which Jesus had
said.
23 Now when he was in Jerusalem at the
Passover, during the feast, many believed
in his name, observing his signs which he
did.
24 But Jesus didn’t entrust himself to
them, because he knew everyone,
25 and because he didn’t need for
anyone to testify concerning man; for he
himself knew what was in man.

3

1 Now there was a man of the Pharisees
named Nicodemus, a ruler of the Jews.
2 He came to Jesus by night and said to
him, “Rabbi, we know that you are a
teacher come from God, for no one can do
these signs that you do, unless God is with
him.”
3 Jesus answered him, “Most certainly I
tell you, unless one is born anew, † he
can’t see God’s Kingdom.”
4 Nicodemus said to him, “How can a
man be born when he is old? Can he enter
a second time into his mother’s womb and
be born?”
5 Jesus answered, “Most certainly I tell
you, unless one is born of water and
Spirit, he can’t enter into God’s Kingdom.
6 That which is born of the flesh is flesh.
That which is born of the Spirit is spirit.
7 Don’t marvel that I said to you, ‘You
must be born anew.’
8 The wind‡ blows where it wants to,
and you hear its sound, but don’t know
where it comes from and where it is going.
So is everyone who is born of the Spirit.”
9 Nicodemus answered him, “How can
these things be?”
10 Jesus answered him, “Are you the
teacher of Israel, and don’t understand
these things?
11 Most certainly I tell you, we speak
that which we know and testify of that
which we have seen, and you don’t
receive our witness.
12 If I told you earthly things and you
don’t believe, how will you believe if I tell
you heavenly things?
13 No one has ascended into heaven but
he who descended out of heaven, the Son
of Man, who is in heaven.
14 As Moses lifted up the serpent in the
wilderness, even so must the Son of Man
be lifted up,
15 that whoever believes in him should
not perish, but have eternal life.

* **2:17** Psalms 69:9 † **3:3** The word translated “anew” here and in John 3:7 (ἄνωθεν) also means “again” and “from above”. ‡ **3:8** The same Greek word (πνεῦμα) means wind, breath, and spirit. § **3:16** The phrase “only born” is from the Greek word “μονογενη”, which is sometimes translated “only begotten” or “one and only”.

16 For God so loved the world, that he
gave his only born§ Son, that whoever
believes in him should not perish, but
have eternal life.
17 For God didn't send his Son into the
world to judge the world, but that the
world should be saved through him.
18 He who believes in him is not judged.
He who doesn't believe has been judged
already, because he has not believed in
the name of the only born Son of God.
19 This is the judgment, that the light has
come into the world, and men loved the
darkness rather than the light, for their
works were evil.
20 For everyone who does evil hates the
light and doesn't come to the light, lest his
works would be exposed.
21 But he who does the truth comes to
the light, that his works may be revealed,
that they have been done in God."

22 After these things, Jesus came with
his disciples into the land of Judea. He
stayed there with them and baptized.
23 John also was baptizing in Enon near
Salim, because there was much water
there. They came and were baptized;
24 for John was not yet thrown into
prison.
25 Therefore a dispute arose on the part
of John's disciples with some Jews about
purification.
26 They came to John and said to him,
"Rabbi, he who was with you beyond the
Jordan, to whom you have testified,
behold, he baptizes, and everyone is
coming to him."

27 John answered, "A man can receive
nothing unless it has been given him from
heaven.
28 You yourselves testify that I said, 'I am
not the Christ,' but, 'I have been sent
before him.'
29 He who has the bride is the
bridegroom; but the friend of the
bridegroom, who stands and hears him,
rejoices greatly because of the
bridegroom's voice. Therefore my joy is
made full.
30 He must increase, but I must
decrease.
31 "He who comes from above is above
all. He who is from the earth belongs to
the earth and speaks of the earth. He who
comes from heaven is above all.
32 What he has seen and heard, of that
he testifies; and no one receives his
witness.
33 He who has received his witness has
set his seal to this, that God is true.
34 For he whom God has sent speaks the
words of God; for God gives the Spirit
without measure.
35 The Father loves the Son, and has
given all things into his hand.
36 One who believes in the Son has
eternal life, but one who disobeys† the
Son won't see life, but the wrath of God
remains on him."

4

1 Therefore when the Lord knew that
the Pharisees had heard that Jesus was
making and baptizing more disciples than
John
2 (although Jesus himself didn't baptize,
but his disciples),
3 he left Judea and departed into Galilee.
4 He needed to pass through Samaria.
5 So he came to a city of Samaria called
Sychar, near the parcel of ground that
Jacob gave to his son Joseph.
6 Jacob's well was there. Jesus therefore,
being tired from his journey, sat down by
the well. It was about the sixth hour.†
7 A woman of Samaria came to draw
water. Jesus said to her, "Give me a drink."
8 For his disciples had gone away into
the city to buy food.
9 The Samaritan woman therefore said
to him, "How is it that you, being a Jew,
ask for a drink from me, a Samaritan
woman?" (For Jews have no dealings with
Samaritans.)
10 Jesus answered her, "If you knew the
gift of God, and who it is who says to you,
'Give me a drink,' you would have asked
him, and he would have given you living
water."
11 The woman said to him, "Sir, you
have nothing to draw with, and the well is

† **3:36** The same word can be translated "disobeys" or "disbelieves" in this context. † **4:6** noon

deep. So where do you get that living
water?
12 Are you greater than our father Jacob,
who gave us the well and drank from it
himself, as did his children and his
livestock?"
13 Jesus answered her, "Everyone who
drinks of this water will thirst again,
14 but whoever drinks of the water that I
will give him will never thirst again; but
the water that I will give him will become
in him a well of water springing up to
eternal life."
15 The woman said to him, "Sir, give me
this water, so that I don't get thirsty,
neither come all the way here to draw."
16 Jesus said to her, "Go, call your
husband, and come here."
17 The woman answered, "I have no
husband."
Jesus said to her, "You said well, 'I have
no husband,'
18 for you have had five husbands; and
he whom you now have is not your
husband. This you have said truly."
19 The woman said to him, "Sir, I
perceive that you are a prophet.
20 Our fathers worshiped in this
mountain, and you Jews say that in
Jerusalem is the place where people ought
to worship."
21 Jesus said to her, "Woman, believe
me, the hour is coming when neither in
this mountain nor in Jerusalem will you
worship the Father.
22 You worship that which you don't
know. We worship that which we know;
for salvation is from the Jews.
23 But the hour comes, and now is, when
the true worshipers will worship the
Father in spirit and truth, for the Father
seeks such to be his worshipers.
24 God is spirit, and those who worship
him must worship in spirit and truth."
25 The woman said to him, "I know that
Messiah is coming, he who is called
Christ.‡ When he has come, he will
declare to us all things."
26 Jesus said to her, "I am he, the one
who speaks to you."
27 Just then, his disciples came. They
marveled that he was speaking with a
woman; yet no one said, "What are you
looking for?" or, "Why do you speak with
her?"
28 So the woman left her water pot, went
away into the city, and said to the people,
29 "Come, see a man who told me
everything that I have done. Can this be
the Christ?"
30 They went out of the city, and were
coming to him.
31 In the meanwhile, the disciples urged
him, saying, "Rabbi, eat."
32 But he said to them, "I have food to
eat that you don't know about."
33 The disciples therefore said to one
another, "Has anyone brought him
something to eat?"
34 Jesus said to them, "My food is to do
the will of him who sent me and to
accomplish his work.
35 Don't you say, 'There are yet four
months until the harvest'? Behold, I tell
you, lift up your eyes and look at the fields,
that they are white for harvest already.
36 He who reaps receives wages and
gathers fruit to eternal life, that both he
who sows and he who reaps may rejoice
together.
37 For in this the saying is true, 'One
sows, and another reaps.'
38 I sent you to reap that for which you
haven't labored. Others have labored, and
you have entered into their labor."
39 From that city many of the
Samaritans believed in him because of the
word of the woman, who testified, "He
told me everything that I have done."
40 So when the Samaritans came to him,
they begged him to stay with them. He
stayed there two days.
41 Many more believed because of his
word.
42 They said to the woman, "Now we
believe, not because of your speaking; for
we have heard for ourselves, and know
that this is indeed the Christ, the Savior of
the world."

‡ **4:25** "Messiah" (Hebrew) and "Christ" (Greek) both mean "Anointed One".

43 After the two days he went out from
there and went into Galilee.
44 For Jesus himself testified that a
prophet has no honor in his own country.
45 So when he came into Galilee, the
Galileans received him, having seen all
the things that he did in Jerusalem at the
feast, for they also went to the feast.
46 Jesus came therefore again to Cana of
Galilee, where he made the water into
wine. There was a certain nobleman
whose son was sick at Capernaum.
47 When he heard that Jesus had come
out of Judea into Galilee, he went to him
and begged him that he would come down
and heal his son, for he was at the point of
death.
48 Jesus therefore said to him, "Unless
you see signs and wonders, you will in no
way believe."
49 The nobleman said to him, "Sir, come
down before my child dies."
50 Jesus said to him, "Go your way. Your
son lives." The man believed the word
that Jesus spoke to him, and he went his
way.
51 As he was going down, his servants
met him and reported, saying "Your child
lives!"
52 So he inquired of them the hour when
he began to get better. They said therefore
to him, "Yesterday at the seventh hour,§
the fever left him."
53 So the father knew that it was at that
hour in which Jesus said to him, "Your son
lives." He believed, as did his whole
house.
54 This is again the second sign that
Jesus did, having come out of Judea into
Galilee.

5

1 After these things, there was a feast of
the Jews, and Jesus went up to Jerusalem.
2 Now in Jerusalem by the sheep gate,
there is a pool, which is called in Hebrew,
"Bethesda", having five porches.
3 In these lay a great multitude of those
who were sick, blind, lame, or paralyzed,
waiting for the moving of the water;
4 for an angel went down at certain
times into the pool and stirred up the
water. Whoever stepped in first after the
stirring of the water was healed of
whatever disease he had.†
5 A certain man was there who had
been sick for thirty-eight years.
6 When Jesus saw him lying there, and
knew that he had been sick for a long
time, he asked him, "Do you want to be
made well?"
7 The sick man answered him, "Sir, I
have no one to put me into the pool when
the water is stirred up, but while I'm
coming, another steps down before me."
8 Jesus said to him, "Arise, take up your
mat, and walk."
9 Immediately, the man was made well,
and took up his mat and walked.
Now that day was a Sabbath.
10 So the Jews said to him who was
cured, "It is the Sabbath. It is not lawful
for you to carry the mat."
11 He answered them, "He who made
me well said to me, 'Take up your mat and
walk.' "
12 Then they asked him, "Who is the
man who said to you, 'Take up your mat
and walk'?"
13 But he who was healed didn't know
who it was, for Jesus had withdrawn, a
crowd being in the place.
14 Afterward Jesus found him in the
temple and said to him, "Behold, you are
made well. Sin no more, so that nothing
worse happens to you."
15 The man went away, and told the Jews
that it was Jesus who had made him well.
16 For this cause the Jews persecuted
Jesus and sought to kill him, because he
did these things on the Sabbath.
17 But Jesus answered them, "My Father
is still working, so I am working, too."
18 For this cause therefore the Jews
sought all the more to kill him, because he
not only broke the Sabbath, but also
called God his own Father, making
himself equal with God.
19 Jesus therefore answered them,
"Most certainly, I tell you, the Son can do

§ **4:52** 1:00 p.m. † **5:4** NU omits from "waiting" in verse 3 to the end of verse 4.

nothing of himself, but what he sees the Father doing. For whatever things he does, these the Son also does likewise.
20 For the Father has affection for the Son, and shows him all things that he himself does. He will show him greater works than these, that you may marvel.
21 For as the Father raises the dead and gives them life, even so the Son also gives life to whom he desires.
22 For the Father judges no one, but he has given all judgment to the Son,
23 that all may honor the Son, even as they honor the Father. He who doesn't honor the Son doesn't honor the Father who sent him.
24 "Most certainly I tell you, he who hears my word and believes him who sent me has eternal life, and doesn't come into judgment, but has passed out of death into life.
25 Most certainly I tell you, the hour comes, and now is, when the dead will hear the Son of God's voice; and those who hear will live.
26 For as the Father has life in himself, even so he gave to the Son also to have life in himself.
27 He also gave him authority to execute judgment, because he is a son of man.
28 Don't marvel at this, for the hour comes in which all who are in the tombs will hear his voice
29 and will come out; those who have done good, to the resurrection of life; and those who have done evil, to the resurrection of judgment.
30 I can of myself do nothing. As I hear, I judge; and my judgment is righteous, because I don't seek my own will, but the will of my Father who sent me.
31 "If I testify about myself, my witness is not valid.
32 It is another who testifies about me. I know that the testimony which he testifies about me is true.
33 You have sent to John, and he has testified to the truth.
34 But the testimony which I receive is not from man. However, I say these things that you may be saved.
35 He was the burning and shining lamp, and you were willing to rejoice for a while in his light.
36 But the testimony which I have is greater than that of John; for the works which the Father gave me to accomplish, the very works that I do, testify about me, that the Father has sent me.
37 The Father himself, who sent me, has testified about me. You have neither heard his voice at any time, nor seen his form.
38 You don't have his word living in you, because you don't believe him whom he sent.
39 "You search the Scriptures, because you think that in them you have eternal life; and these are they which testify about me.
40 Yet you will not come to me, that you may have life.
41 I don't receive glory from men.
42 But I know you, that you don't have God's love in yourselves.
43 I have come in my Father's name, and you don't receive me. If another comes in his own name, you will receive him.
44 How can you believe, who receive glory from one another, and you don't seek the glory that comes from the only God?
45 "Don't think that I will accuse you to the Father. There is one who accuses you, even Moses, on whom you have set your hope.
46 For if you believed Moses, you would believe me; for he wrote about me.
47 But if you don't believe his writings, how will you believe my words?"

6

1 After these things, Jesus went away to the other side of the sea of Galilee, which is also called the Sea of Tiberias.
2 A great multitude followed him, because they saw his signs which he did on those who were sick.
3 Jesus went up into the mountain, and he sat there with his disciples.
4 Now the Passover, the feast of the Jews, was at hand.
5 Jesus therefore, lifting up his eyes and seeing that a great multitude was coming

to him, said to Philip, "Where are we to buy bread, that these may eat?"
6 He said this to test him, for he himself knew what he would do.
7 Philip answered him, "Two hundred denarii† worth of bread is not sufficient for them, that every one of them may receive a little."
8 One of his disciples, Andrew, Simon Peter's brother, said to him,
9 "There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish, but what are these among so many?"
10 Jesus said, "Have the people sit down." Now there was much grass in that place. So the men sat down, in number about five thousand.
11 Jesus took the loaves, and having given thanks, he distributed to the disciples, and the disciples to those who were sitting down, likewise also of the fish as much as they desired.
12 When they were filled, he said to his disciples, "Gather up the broken pieces which are left over, that nothing be lost."
13 So they gathered them up, and filled twelve baskets with broken pieces from the five barley loaves, which were left over by those who had eaten.
14 When therefore the people saw the sign which Jesus did, they said, "This is truly the prophet who comes into the world."
15 Jesus therefore, perceiving that they were about to come and take him by force to make him king, withdrew again to the mountain by himself.
16 When evening came, his disciples went down to the sea.
17 They entered into the boat, and were going over the sea to Capernaum. It was now dark, and Jesus had not come to them.
18 The sea was tossed by a great wind blowing.
19 When therefore they had rowed about twenty-five or thirty stadia,‡ they saw Jesus walking on the sea* and drawing near to the boat; and they were afraid.
20 But he said to them, "It is I.§ Don't be afraid."
21 They were willing therefore to receive him into the boat. Immediately the boat was at the land where they were going.
22 On the next day, the multitude that stood on the other side of the sea saw that there was no other boat there, except the one in which his disciples had embarked, and that Jesus hadn't entered with his disciples into the boat, but his disciples had gone away alone.
23 However, boats from Tiberias came near to the place where they ate the bread after the Lord had given thanks.
24 When the multitude therefore saw that Jesus wasn't there, nor his disciples, they themselves got into the boats and came to Capernaum, seeking Jesus.
25 When they found him on the other side of the sea, they asked him, "Rabbi, when did you come here?"
26 Jesus answered them, "Most certainly I tell you, you seek me, not because you saw signs, but because you ate of the loaves and were filled.
27 Don't work for the food which perishes, but for the food which remains to eternal life, which the Son of Man will give to you. For God the Father has sealed him."
28 They said therefore to him, "What must we do, that we may work the works of God?"
29 Jesus answered them, "This is the work of God, that you believe in him whom he has sent."
30 They said therefore to him, "What then do you do for a sign, that we may see and believe you? What work do you do?
31 Our fathers ate the manna in the wilderness. As it is written, 'He gave them bread out of heaven† to eat.' "*

† **6:7** A denarius was a silver coin worth about a day's wages for an agricultural laborer, so 200 denarii would be between 6 and 7 month's pay. ‡ **6:19** 25 to 30 stadia is about 5 to 6 kilometers or about 3 to 4 miles * **6:19** See Job 9:8 § **6:20** or, I AM † **6:31** Greek and Hebrew use the same word for "heaven", "the heavens", "the sky", and "the air". * **6:31** Exodus 16:4; Nehemiah 9:15; Psalms 78:24-25

32 Jesus therefore said to them, “Most
certainly, I tell you, it wasn’t Moses who
gave you the bread out of heaven, but my
Father gives you the true bread out of
heaven.
33 For the bread of God is that which
comes down out of heaven and gives life
to the world.”
34 They said therefore to him, “Lord,
always give us this bread.”
35 Jesus said to them, “I am the bread of
life. Whoever comes to me will not be
hungry, and whoever believes in me will
never be thirsty.
36 But I told you that you have seen me,
and yet you don’t believe.
37 All those whom the Father gives me
will come to me. He who comes to me I
will in no way throw out.
38 For I have come down from heaven,
not to do my own will, but the will of him
who sent me.
39 This is the will of my Father who sent
me, that of all he has given to me I should
lose nothing, but should raise him up at
the last day.
40 This is the will of the one who sent
me, that everyone who sees the Son and
believes in him should have eternal life;
and I will raise him up at the last day.”
41 The Jews therefore murmured
concerning him, because he said, “I am
the bread which came down out of
heaven.”
42 They said, “Isn’t this Jesus, the son of
Joseph, whose father and mother we
know? How then does he say, ‘I have
come down out of heaven’?”
43 Therefore Jesus answered them,
“Don’t murmur among yourselves.
44 No one can come to me unless the
Father who sent me draws him; and I will
raise him up in the last day.
45 It is written in the prophets, ‘They will
all be taught by God.’ * Therefore
everyone who hears from the Father and
has learned, comes to me.
46 Not that anyone has seen the Father,
except he who is from God. He has seen
the Father.
47 Most certainly, I tell you, he who
believes in me has eternal life.
48 I am the bread of life.
49 Your fathers ate the manna in the
wilderness and they died.
50 This is the bread which comes down
out of heaven, that anyone may eat of it
and not die.
51 I am the living bread which came
down out of heaven. If anyone eats of this
bread, he will live forever. Yes, the bread
which I will give for the life of the world is
my flesh.”
52 The Jews therefore contended with
one another, saying, “How can this man
give us his flesh to eat?”
53 Jesus therefore said to them, “Most
certainly I tell you, unless you eat the
flesh of the Son of Man and drink his
blood, you don’t have life in yourselves.
54 He who eats my flesh and drinks my
blood has eternal life, and I will raise him
up at the last day.
55 For my flesh is food indeed, and my
blood is drink indeed.
56 He who eats my flesh and drinks my
blood lives in me, and I in him.
57 As the living Father sent me, and I live
because of the Father, so he who feeds on
me will also live because of me.
58 This is the bread which came down
out of heaven—not as our fathers ate the
manna and died. He who eats this bread
will live forever.”
59 He said these things in the synagogue,
as he taught in Capernaum.
60 Therefore many of his disciples, when
they heard this, said, “This is a hard
saying! Who can listen to it?”
61 But Jesus knowing in himself that his
disciples murmured at this, said to them,
“Does this cause you to stumble?
62 Then what if you would see the Son of
Man ascending to where he was before?
63 It is the spirit who gives life. The flesh
profits nothing. The words that I speak to
you are spirit, and are life.
64 But there are some of you who don’t
believe.” For Jesus knew from the
beginning who they were who didn’t

* **6:45** Isaiah 54:13

believe, and who it was who would betray him.
65 He said, "For this cause I have said to you that no one can come to me, unless it is given to him by my Father."
66 At this, many of his disciples went back and walked no more with him.
67 Jesus said therefore to the twelve, "You don't also want to go away, do you?"
68 Simon Peter answered him, "Lord, to whom would we go? You have the words of eternal life.
69 We have come to believe and know that you are the Christ, the Son of the living God."
70 Jesus answered them, "Didn't I choose you, the twelve, and one of you is a devil?"
71 Now he spoke of Judas, the son of Simon Iscariot, for it was he who would betray him, being one of the twelve.

7

1 After these things, Jesus was walking in Galilee, for he wouldn't walk in Judea, because the Jews sought to kill him.
2 Now the feast of the Jews, the Feast of Booths, was at hand.
3 His brothers therefore said to him, "Depart from here and go into Judea, that your disciples also may see your works which you do.
4 For no one does anything in secret while he seeks to be known openly. If you do these things, reveal yourself to the world."
5 For even his brothers didn't believe in him.
6 Jesus therefore said to them, "My time has not yet come, but your time is always ready.
7 The world can't hate you, but it hates me, because I testify about it, that its works are evil.
8 You go up to the feast. I am not yet going up to this feast, because my time is not yet fulfilled."
9 Having said these things to them, he stayed in Galilee.
10 But when his brothers had gone up to the feast, then he also went up, not publicly, but as it were in secret.
11 The Jews therefore sought him at the feast, and said, "Where is he?"
12 There was much murmuring among the multitudes concerning him. Some said, "He is a good man." Others said, "Not so, but he leads the multitude astray."
13 Yet no one spoke openly of him for fear of the Jews.
14 But when it was now the middle of the feast, Jesus went up into the temple and taught.
15 The Jews therefore marveled, saying, "How does this man know letters, having never been educated?"
16 Jesus therefore answered them, "My teaching is not mine, but his who sent me.
17 If anyone desires to do his will, he will know about the teaching, whether it is from God or if I am speaking from myself.
18 He who speaks from himself seeks his own glory, but he who seeks the glory of him who sent him is true, and no unrighteousness is in him.
19 Didn't Moses give you the law, and yet none of you keeps the law? Why do you seek to kill me?"
20 The multitude answered, "You have a demon! Who seeks to kill you?"
21 Jesus answered them, "I did one work and you all marvel because of it.
22 Moses has given you circumcision (not that it is of Moses, but of the fathers), and on the Sabbath you circumcise a boy.
23 If a boy receives circumcision on the Sabbath, that the law of Moses may not be broken, are you angry with me because I made a man completely healthy on the Sabbath?
24 Don't judge according to appearance, but judge righteous judgment."
25 Therefore some of them of Jerusalem said, "Isn't this he whom they seek to kill?
26 Behold, he speaks openly, and they say nothing to him. Can it be that the rulers indeed know that this is truly the Christ?
27 However, we know where this man comes from, but when the Christ comes, no one will know where he comes from."
28 Jesus therefore cried out in the temple, teaching and saying, "You both know me, and know where I am from. I

have not come of myself, but he who sent me is true, whom you don't know.
29 I know him, because I am from him, and he sent me."
30 They sought therefore to take him; but no one laid a hand on him, because his hour had not yet come.
31 But of the multitude, many believed in him. They said, "When the Christ comes, he won't do more signs than those which this man has done, will he?"
32 The Pharisees heard the multitude murmuring these things concerning him, and the chief priests and the Pharisees sent officers to arrest him.
33 Then Jesus said, "I will be with you a little while longer, then I go to him who sent me.
34 You will seek me and won't find me. You can't come where I am."
35 The Jews therefore said among themselves, "Where will this man go that we won't find him? Will he go to the Dispersion among the Greeks and teach the Greeks?
36 What is this word that he said, 'You will seek me, and won't find me;' and 'Where I am, you can't come'?"
37 Now on the last and greatest day of the feast, Jesus stood and cried out, "If anyone is thirsty, let him come to me and drink!
38 He who believes in me, as the Scripture has said, from within him will flow rivers of living water."
39 But he said this about the Spirit, which those believing in him were to receive. For the Holy Spirit was not yet given, because Jesus wasn't yet glorified.
40 Many of the multitude therefore, when they heard these words, said, "This is truly the prophet."
41 Others said, "This is the Christ." But some said, "What, does the Christ come out of Galilee?
42 Hasn't the Scripture said that the Christ comes of the offspring† of David,* and from Bethlehem,* the village where David was?"
43 So a division arose in the multitude because of him.
44 Some of them would have arrested him, but no one laid hands on him.
45 The officers therefore came to the chief priests and Pharisees; and they said to them, "Why didn't you bring him?"
46 The officers answered, "No man ever spoke like this man!"
47 The Pharisees therefore answered them, "You aren't also led astray, are you?
48 Have any of the rulers or any of the Pharisees believed in him?
49 But this multitude that doesn't know the law is cursed."
50 Nicodemus (he who came to him by night, being one of them) said to them,
51 "Does our law judge a man unless it first hears from him personally and knows what he does?"
52 They answered him, "Are you also from Galilee? Search and see that no prophet has arisen out of Galilee."*
53 Everyone went to his own house,

8

1 but Jesus went to the Mount of Olives.
2 Now very early in the morning, he came again into the temple, and all the people came to him. He sat down and taught them.
3 The scribes and the Pharisees brought a woman taken in adultery. Having set her in the middle,
4 they told him, "Teacher, we found this woman in adultery, in the very act.
5 Now in our law, Moses commanded us to stone such women.* What then do you say about her?"
6 They said this testing him, that they might have something to accuse him of.
But Jesus stooped down and wrote on the ground with his finger.
7 But when they continued asking him, he looked up and said to them, "He who is without sin among you, let him throw the first stone at her."
8 Again he stooped down and wrote on the ground with his finger.
9 They, when they heard it, being convicted by their conscience, went out one by one, beginning from the oldest,

† **7:42** or, seed * **7:42** 2 Samuel 7:12 * **7:42** Micah 5:2 * **7:52** See Isaiah 9:1; Matthew 4:13-16 * **8:5** Leviticus 20:10; Deuteronomy 22:22

even to the last. Jesus was left alone with the woman where she was, in the middle.
10 Jesus, standing up, saw her and said, "Woman, where are your accusers? Did no one condemn you?"
11 She said, "No one, Lord."
Jesus said, "Neither do I condemn you. Go your way. From now on, sin no more."†
12 Again, therefore, Jesus spoke to them, saying, "I am the light of the world.* He who follows me will not walk in the darkness, but will have the light of life."
13 The Pharisees therefore said to him, "You testify about yourself. Your testimony is not valid."
14 Jesus answered them, "Even if I testify about myself, my testimony is true, for I know where I came from, and where I am going; but you don't know where I came from, or where I am going.
15 You judge according to the flesh. I judge no one.
16 Even if I do judge, my judgment is true, for I am not alone, but I am with the Father who sent me.
17 It's also written in your law that the testimony of two people is valid.*
18 I am one who testifies about myself, and the Father who sent me testifies about me."
19 They said therefore to him, "Where is your Father?"
Jesus answered, "You know neither me nor my Father. If you knew me, you would know my Father also."
20 Jesus spoke these words in the treasury, as he taught in the temple. Yet no one arrested him, because his hour had not yet come.
21 Jesus said therefore again to them, "I am going away, and you will seek me, and you will die in your sins. Where I go, you can't come."
22 The Jews therefore said, "Will he kill himself, because he says, 'Where I am going, you can't come'?"
23 He said to them, "You are from beneath. I am from above. You are of this world. I am not of this world.
24 I said therefore to you that you will die in your sins; for unless you believe that I am‡ he, you will die in your sins."
25 They said therefore to him, "Who are you?"
Jesus said to them, "Just what I have been saying to you from the beginning.
26 I have many things to speak and to judge concerning you. However, he who sent me is true; and the things which I heard from him, these I say to the world."
27 They didn't understand that he spoke to them about the Father.
28 Jesus therefore said to them, "When you have lifted up the Son of Man, then you will know that I am he, and I do nothing of myself, but as my Father taught me, I say these things.
29 He who sent me is with me. The Father hasn't left me alone, for I always do the things that are pleasing to him."
30 As he spoke these things, many believed in him.
31 Jesus therefore said to those Jews who had believed him, "If you remain in my word, then you are truly my disciples.
32 You will know the truth, and the truth will make you free." *
33 They answered him, "We are Abraham's offspring, and have never been in bondage to anyone. How do you say, 'You will be made free'?"
34 Jesus answered them, "Most certainly I tell you, everyone who commits sin is the bondservant of sin.
35 A bondservant doesn't live in the house forever. A son remains forever.
36 If therefore the Son makes you free, you will be free indeed.
37 I know that you are Abraham's offspring, yet you seek to kill me, because my word finds no place in you.
38 I say the things which I have seen with my Father; and you also do the things which you have seen with your father."
39 They answered him, "Our father is Abraham."

† **8:11** NU includes John 7:53–John 8:11, but puts brackets around it to indicate that the textual critics had less confidence that this was original. * **8:12** Isaiah 60:1 * **8:17** Deuteronomy 17:6; 19:15 ‡ **8:24** or, I AM * **8:32** Psalms 119:45

Jesus said to them, “If you were
Abraham’s children, you would do the
works of Abraham.
40 But now you seek to kill me, a man
who has told you the truth which I heard
from God. Abraham didn’t do this.
41 You do the works of your father.”

They said to him, “We were not born of
sexual immorality. We have one Father,
God.”
42 Therefore Jesus said to them, “If God
were your father, you would love me, for I
came out and have come from God. For I
haven’t come of myself, but he sent me.
43 Why don’t you understand my
speech? Because you can’t hear my word.
44 You are of your father the devil, and
you want to do the desires of your father.
He was a murderer from the beginning,
and doesn’t stand in the truth, because
there is no truth in him. When he speaks a
lie, he speaks on his own; for he is a liar,
and the father of lies.
45 But because I tell the truth, you don’t
believe me.
46 Which of you convicts me of sin? If I
tell the truth, why do you not believe me?
47 He who is of God hears the words of
God. For this cause you don’t hear,
because you are not of God.”

48 Then the Jews answered him, “Don’t
we say well that you are a Samaritan, and
have a demon?”
49 Jesus answered, “I don’t have a
demon, but I honor my Father and you
dishonor me.
50 But I don’t seek my own glory. There
is one who seeks and judges.
51 Most certainly, I tell you, if a person
keeps my word, he will never see death.”

52 Then the Jews said to him, “Now we
know that you have a demon. Abraham
died, as did the prophets; and you say, ‘If a
man keeps my word, he will never taste of
death.’
53 Are you greater than our father
Abraham, who died? The prophets died.
Who do you make yourself out to be?”

54 Jesus answered, “If I glorify myself,
my glory is nothing. It is my Father who
glorifies me, of whom you say that he is
our God.
55 You have not known him, but I know
him. If I said, ‘I don’t know him,’ I would
be like you, a liar. But I know him and
keep his word.
56 Your father Abraham rejoiced to see
my day. He saw it and was glad.”

57 The Jews therefore said to him, “You
are not yet fifty years old! Have you seen
Abraham?”
58 Jesus said to them, “Most certainly, I
tell you, before Abraham came into
existence, I AM.*”
59 Therefore they took up stones to
throw at him, but Jesus hid himself and
went out of the temple, having gone
through the middle of them, and so
passed by.

9

1 As he passed by, he saw a man blind
from birth.
2 His disciples asked him, “Rabbi, who
sinned, this man or his parents, that he
was born blind?”
3 Jesus answered, “This man didn’t sin,
nor did his parents, but that the works of
God might be revealed in him.
4 I must work the works of him who sent
me while it is day. The night is coming,
when no one can work.
5 While I am in the world, I am the light
of the world.”
6 When he had said this, he spat on the
ground, made mud with the saliva,
anointed the blind man’s eyes with the
mud,
7 and said to him, “Go, wash in the pool
of Siloam” (which means “Sent”). So he
went away, washed, and came back
seeing.
8 Therefore the neighbors and those
who saw that he was blind before said,
“Isn’t this he who sat and begged?”
9 Others were saying, “It is he.” Still
others were saying, “He looks like him.”
He said, “I am he.”
10 They therefore were asking him,
“How were your eyes opened?”

* **8:58** Exodus 3:14

11 He answered, “A man called Jesus
made mud, anointed my eyes, and said to
me, ‘Go to the pool of Siloam and wash.’
So I went away and washed, and I
received sight.”
12 Then they asked him, “Where is he?”
He said, “I don’t know.”
13 They brought him who had been
blind to the Pharisees.
14 It was a Sabbath when Jesus made the
mud and opened his eyes.
15 Again therefore the Pharisees also
asked him how he received his sight. He
said to them, “He put mud on my eyes, I
washed, and I see.”
16 Some therefore of the Pharisees said,
“This man is not from God, because he
doesn’t keep the Sabbath.”
Others said, “How can a man who is a
sinner do such signs?” So there was
division among them.
17 Therefore they asked the blind man
again, “What do you say about him,
because he opened your eyes?”
He said, “He is a prophet.”
18 The Jews therefore didn’t believe
concerning him, that he had been blind
and had received his sight, until they
called the parents of him who had
received his sight,
19 and asked them, “Is this your son,
whom you say was born blind? How then
does he now see?”
20 His parents answered them, “We
know that this is our son, and that he was
born blind;
21 but how he now sees, we don’t know;
or who opened his eyes, we don’t know.
He is of age. Ask him. He will speak for
himself.”
22 His parents said these things because
they feared the Jews; for the Jews had
already agreed that if any man would
confess him as Christ, he would be put out
of the synagogue.
23 Therefore his parents said, “He is of
age. Ask him.”
24 So they called the man who was blind
a second time, and said to him, “Give glory
to God. We know that this man is a
sinner.”
25 He therefore answered, “I don’t know
if he is a sinner. One thing I do know: that
though I was blind, now I see.”
26 They said to him again, “What did he
do to you? How did he open your eyes?”
27 He answered them, “I told you
already, and you didn’t listen. Why do you
want to hear it again? You don’t also want
to become his disciples, do you?”
28 They insulted him and said, “You are
his disciple, but we are disciples of Moses.
29 We know that God has spoken to
Moses. But as for this man, we don’t know
where he comes from.”
30 The man answered them, “How
amazing! You don’t know where he comes
from, yet he opened my eyes.
31 We know that God doesn’t listen to
sinners, but if anyone is a worshiper of
God and does his will, he listens to him.*
32 Since the world began it has never
been heard of that anyone opened the
eyes of someone born blind.
33 If this man were not from God, he
could do nothing.”
34 They answered him, “You were
altogether born in sins, and do you teach
us?” Then they threw him out.
35 Jesus heard that they had thrown him
out, and finding him, he said, “Do you
believe in the Son of God?”
36 He answered, “Who is he, Lord, that I
may believe in him?”
37 Jesus said to him, “You have both seen
him, and it is he who speaks with you.”
38 He said, “Lord, I believe!” and he
worshiped him.
39 Jesus said, “I came into this world for
judgment, that those who don’t see may
see; and that those who see may become
blind.”
40 Those of the Pharisees who were with
him heard these things, and said to him,
“Are we also blind?”
41 Jesus said to them, “If you were blind,
you would have no sin; but now you say,
‘We see.’ Therefore your sin remains.

* **9:31** Psalms 66:18; Proverbs 15:29; 28:9

10

1 “Most certainly, I tell you, one who
doesn’t enter by the door into the sheep
fold, but climbs up some other way, is a
thief and a robber.
2 But one who enters in by the door is
the shepherd of the sheep.
3 The gatekeeper opens the gate for him,
and the sheep listen to his voice. He calls
his own sheep by name and leads them
out.
4 Whenever he brings out his own
sheep, he goes before them; and the sheep
follow him, for they know his voice.
5 They will by no means follow a
stranger, but will flee from him; for they
don’t know the voice of strangers.”
6 Jesus spoke this parable to them, but
they didn’t understand what he was
telling them.
7 Jesus therefore said to them again,
“Most certainly, I tell you, I am the sheep’s
door.
8 All who came before me are thieves
and robbers, but the sheep didn’t listen to
them.
9 I am the door. If anyone enters in by
me, he will be saved, and will go in and go
out and will find pasture.
10 The thief only comes to steal, kill, and
destroy. I came that they may have life,
and may have it abundantly.
11 “I am the good shepherd.* The good
shepherd lays down his life for the sheep.
12 He who is a hired hand, and not a
shepherd, who doesn’t own the sheep,
sees the wolf coming, leaves the sheep,
and flees. The wolf snatches the sheep
and scatters them.
13 The hired hand flees because he is a
hired hand and doesn’t care for the sheep.
14 I am the good shepherd. I know my
own, and I’m known by my own;
15 even as the Father knows me, and I
know the Father. I lay down my life for
the sheep.
16 I have other sheep which are not of
this fold.* I must bring them also, and
they will hear my voice. They will become
one flock with one shepherd.
17 Therefore the Father loves me,
because I lay down my life, * that I may
take it again.
18 No one takes it away from me, but I
lay it down by myself. I have power to lay
it down, and I have power to take it again.
I received this commandment from my
Father.”
19 Therefore a division arose again
among the Jews because of these words.
20 Many of them said, “He has a demon
and is insane! Why do you listen to him?”
21 Others said, “These are not the
sayings of one possessed by a demon. It
isn’t possible for a demon to open the eyes
of the blind, is it?”*
22 It was the Feast of the Dedication† at
Jerusalem.
23 It was winter, and Jesus was walking
in the temple, in Solomon’s porch.
24 The Jews therefore came around him
and said to him, “How long will you hold
us in suspense? If you are the Christ, tell
us plainly.”
25 Jesus answered them, “I told you, and
you don’t believe. The works that I do in
my Father’s name, these testify about me.
26 But you don’t believe, because you
are not of my sheep, as I told you.
27 My sheep hear my voice, and I know
them, and they follow me.
28 I give eternal life to them. They will
never perish, and no one will snatch them
out of my hand.
29 My Father who has given them to me
is greater than all. No one is able to snatch
them out of my Father’s hand.
30 I and the Father are one.”
31 Therefore the Jews took up stones
again to stone him.
32 Jesus answered them, “I have shown
you many good works from my Father.
For which of those works do you stone
me?”
33 The Jews answered him, “We don’t
stone you for a good work, but for

* **10:11** Isaiah 40:11; Ezekiel 34:11-12,15,22 * **10:16** Isaiah 56:8 * **10:17** Isaiah 53:7-8 * **10:21** Exodus 4:11
† **10:22** The “Feast of the Dedication” is the Greek name for “Hanukkah”, a celebration of the rededication of the Temple.

blasphemy, because you, being a man,
make yourself God."
34 Jesus answered them, "Isn't it written
in your law, 'I said, you are gods'?*
35 If he called them gods, to whom the
word of God came (and the Scripture can't
be broken),
36 do you say of him whom the Father
sanctified and sent into the world, 'You
blaspheme,' because I said, 'I am the Son
of God'?
37 If I don't do the works of my Father,
don't believe me.
38 But if I do them, though you don't
believe me, believe the works, that you
may know and believe that the Father is
in me, and I in the Father."
39 They sought again to seize him, and
he went out of their hand.
40 He went away again beyond the
Jordan into the place where John was
baptizing at first, and he stayed there.
41 Many came to him. They said, "John
indeed did no sign, but everything that
John said about this man is true."
42 Many believed in him there.

11

1 Now a certain man was sick, Lazarus
from Bethany, of the village of Mary and
her sister, Martha.
2 It was that Mary who had anointed the
Lord with ointment and wiped his feet
with her hair, whose brother Lazarus was
sick.
3 The sisters therefore sent to him,
saying, "Lord, behold, he for whom you
have great affection is sick."
4 But when Jesus heard it, he said, "This
sickness is not to death, but for the glory of
God, that God's Son may be glorified by it."
5 Now Jesus loved Martha, and her
sister, and Lazarus.
6 When therefore he heard that he was
sick, he stayed two days in the place
where he was.
7 Then after this he said to the disciples,
"Let's go into Judea again."
8 The disciples asked him, "Rabbi, the
Jews were just trying to stone you. Are
you going there again?"
9 Jesus answered, "Aren't there twelve
hours of daylight? If a man walks in the
day, he doesn't stumble, because he sees
the light of this world.
10 But if a man walks in the night, he
stumbles, because the light isn't in him."
11 He said these things, and after that, he
said to them, "Our friend Lazarus has
fallen asleep, but I am going so that I may
awake him out of sleep."
12 The disciples therefore said, "Lord, if
he has fallen asleep, he will recover."
13 Now Jesus had spoken of his death,
but they thought that he spoke of taking
rest in sleep.
14 So Jesus said to them plainly then,
"Lazarus is dead.
15 I am glad for your sakes that I was not
there, so that you may believe.
Nevertheless, let's go to him."
16 Thomas therefore, who is called
Didymus,† said to his fellow disciples,
"Let's also go, that we may die with him."
17 So when Jesus came, he found that he
had been in the tomb four days already.
18 Now Bethany was near Jerusalem,
about fifteen stadia‡ away.
19 Many of the Jews had joined the
women around Martha and Mary, to
console them concerning their brother.
20 Then when Martha heard that Jesus
was coming, she went and met him, but
Mary stayed in the house.
21 Therefore Martha said to Jesus, "Lord,
if you would have been here, my brother
wouldn't have died.
22 Even now I know that whatever you
ask of God, God will give you."
23 Jesus said to her, "Your brother will
rise again."
24 Martha said to him, "I know that he
will rise again in the resurrection at the
last day."
25 Jesus said to her, "I am the
resurrection and the life. He who believes
in me will still live, even if he dies.

* **10:34** Psalms 82:6 † **11:16** "Didymus" means "Twin". ‡ **11:18** 15 stadia is about 2.8 kilometers or 1.7 miles

26 Whoever lives and believes in me will never die. Do you believe this?"
27 She said to him, "Yes, Lord. I have come to believe that you are the Christ, God's Son, he who comes into the world."
28 When she had said this, she went away and called Mary, her sister, secretly, saying, "The Teacher is here and is calling you."
29 When she heard this, she arose quickly and went to him.
30 Now Jesus had not yet come into the village, but was in the place where Martha met him.
31 Then the Jews who were with her in the house and were consoling her, when they saw Mary, that she rose up quickly and went out, followed her, saying, "She is going to the tomb to weep there."
32 Therefore when Mary came to where Jesus was and saw him, she fell down at his feet, saying to him, "Lord, if you would have been here, my brother wouldn't have died."
33 When Jesus therefore saw her weeping, and the Jews weeping who came with her, he groaned in the spirit and was troubled,
34 and said, "Where have you laid him?"
They told him, "Lord, come and see."
35 Jesus wept.
36 The Jews therefore said, "See how much affection he had for him!"
37 Some of them said, "Couldn't this man, who opened the eyes of him who was blind, have also kept this man from dying?"
38 Jesus therefore, again groaning in himself, came to the tomb. Now it was a cave, and a stone lay against it.
39 Jesus said, "Take away the stone."
Martha, the sister of him who was dead, said to him, "Lord, by this time there is a stench, for he has been dead four days."
40 Jesus said to her, "Didn't I tell you that if you believed, you would see God's glory?"
41 So they took away the stone from the place where the dead man was lying.§
Jesus lifted up his eyes and said, "Father, I thank you that you listened to me.
42 I know that you always listen to me, but because of the multitude standing around I said this, that they may believe that you sent me."
43 When he had said this, he cried with a loud voice, "Lazarus, come out!"
44 He who was dead came out, bound hand and foot with wrappings, and his face was wrapped around with a cloth.
Jesus said to them, "Free him, and let him go."
45 Therefore many of the Jews who came to Mary and saw what Jesus did believed in him.
46 But some of them went away to the Pharisees and told them the things which Jesus had done.
47 The chief priests therefore and the Pharisees gathered a council, and said, "What are we doing? For this man does many signs.
48 If we leave him alone like this, everyone will believe in him, and the Romans will come and take away both our place and our nation."
49 But a certain one of them, Caiaphas, being high priest that year, said to them, "You know nothing at all,
50 nor do you consider that it is advantageous for us that one man should die for the people, and that the whole nation not perish."
51 Now he didn't say this of himself, but being high priest that year, he prophesied that Jesus would die for the nation,
52 and not for the nation only, but that he might also gather together into one the children of God who are scattered abroad.
53 So from that day forward they took counsel that they might put him to death.
54 Jesus therefore walked no more openly among the Jews, but departed from there into the country near the wilderness, to a city called Ephraim. He stayed there with his disciples.
55 Now the Passover of the Jews was at hand. Many went up from the country to

§ **11:41** NU omits "from the place where the dead man was lying."

Jerusalem before the Passover, to purify themselves.
56 Then they sought for Jesus and spoke with one another as they stood in the temple, “What do you think—that he isn’t coming to the feast at all?”
57 Now the chief priests and the Pharisees had commanded that if anyone knew where he was, he should report it, that they might seize him.

12

1 Then, six days before the Passover, Jesus came to Bethany, where Lazarus was, who had been dead, whom he raised from the dead.
2 So they made him a supper there. Martha served, but Lazarus was one of those who sat at the table with him.
3 Therefore Mary took a pound† of ointment of pure nard, very precious, and anointed Jesus’ feet and wiped his feet with her hair. The house was filled with the fragrance of the ointment.

4 Then Judas Iscariot, Simon’s son, one of his disciples, who would betray him, said,
5 “Why wasn’t this ointment sold for three hundred denarii‡ and given to the poor?”
6 Now he said this, not because he cared for the poor, but because he was a thief, and having the money box, used to steal what was put into it.

7 But Jesus said, “Leave her alone. She has kept this for the day of my burial.
8 For you always have the poor with you, but you don’t always have me.”

9 A large crowd therefore of the Jews learned that he was there; and they came, not for Jesus’ sake only, but that they might see Lazarus also, whom he had raised from the dead.
10 But the chief priests conspired to put Lazarus to death also,
11 because on account of him many of the Jews went away and believed in Jesus.

12 On the next day a great multitude had come to the feast. When they heard that Jesus was coming to Jerusalem,
13 they took the branches of the palm trees and went out to meet him, and cried out, “Hosanna!§ Blessed is he who comes in the name of the Lord,* the King of Israel!”
14 Jesus, having found a young donkey, sat on it. As it is written,
15 “Don’t be afraid, daughter of Zion. Behold, your King comes, sitting on a donkey’s colt.”*
16 His disciples didn’t understand these things at first, but when Jesus was glorified, then they remembered that these things were written about him, and that they had done these things to him.
17 The multitude therefore that was with him when he called Lazarus out of the tomb and raised him from the dead was testifying about it.
18 For this cause also the multitude went and met him, because they heard that he had done this sign.
19 The Pharisees therefore said among themselves, “See how you accomplish nothing. Behold, the world has gone after him.”
20 Now there were certain Greeks among those who went up to worship at the feast.
21 Therefore, these came to Philip, who was from Bethsaida of Galilee, and asked him, saying, “Sir, we want to see Jesus.”
22 Philip came and told Andrew, and in turn, Andrew came with Philip, and they told Jesus.
23 Jesus answered them, “The time has come for the Son of Man to be glorified.
24 Most certainly I tell you, unless a grain of wheat falls into the earth and dies, it remains by itself alone. But if it dies, it bears much fruit.
25 He who loves his life will lose it. He who hates his life in this world will keep it to eternal life.
26 If anyone serves me, let him follow me. Where I am, there my servant will

† **12:3** a Roman pound of 12 ounces, or about 340 grams ‡ **12:5** 300 denarii was about a year’s wages for an agricultural laborer. § **12:13** “Hosanna” means “save us” or “help us, we pray”. * **12:13** Psalms 118:25-26 * **12:15** Zechariah 9:9

also be. If anyone serves me, the Father
will honor him.
27 “Now my soul is troubled. What shall
I say? ‘Father, save me from this time’?
But I came to this time for this cause.
28 Father, glorify your name!”
Then a voice came out of the sky,
saying, “I have both glorified it and will
glorify it again.”
29 Therefore the multitude who stood by
and heard it said that it had thundered.
Others said, “An angel has spoken to him.”
30 Jesus answered, “This voice hasn’t
come for my sake, but for your sakes.
31 Now is the judgment of this world.
Now the prince of this world will be cast
out.
32 And I, if I am lifted up from the earth,
will draw all people to myself.”
33 But he said this, signifying by what
kind of death he should die.
34 The multitude answered him, “We
have heard out of the law that the Christ
remains forever.* How do you say, ‘The
Son of Man must be lifted up’? Who is this
Son of Man?”
35 Jesus therefore said to them, “Yet a
little while the light is with you. Walk
while you have the light, that darkness
doesn’t overtake you. He who walks in the
darkness doesn’t know where he is going.
36 While you have the light, believe in
the light, that you may become children of
light.” Jesus said these things, and he
departed and hid himself from them.
37 But though he had done so many
signs before them, yet they didn’t believe
in him,
38 that the word of Isaiah the prophet
might be fulfilled, which he spoke:
“Lord, who has believed our report?
To whom has the arm of the Lord
been revealed?”*
39 For this cause they couldn’t believe,
for Isaiah said again:
40 “He has blinded their eyes and he
hardened their heart,
lest they should see with their eyes,
and perceive with their heart,
and would turn,
and I would heal them.”*
41 Isaiah said these things when he saw
his glory, and spoke of him. *
42 Nevertheless, even many of the rulers
believed in him, but because of the
Pharisees they didn’t confess it, so that
they wouldn’t be put out of the synagogue,
43 for they loved men’s praise more than
God’s praise.
44 Jesus cried out and said, “Whoever
believes in me, believes not in me, but in
him who sent me.
45 He who sees me sees him who sent
me.
46 I have come as a light into the world,
that whoever believes in me may not
remain in the darkness.
47 If anyone listens to my sayings and
doesn’t believe, I don’t judge him. For I
came not to judge the world, but to save
the world.
48 He who rejects me, and doesn’t
receive my sayings, has one who judges
him. The word that I spoke will judge him
in the last day.
49 For I spoke not from myself, but the
Father who sent me gave me a
commandment, what I should say and
what I should speak.
50 I know that his commandment is
eternal life. The things therefore which I
speak, even as the Father has said to me,
so I speak.”

13

1 Now before the feast of the Passover,
Jesus, knowing that his time had come
that he would depart from this world to
the Father, having loved his own who
were in the world, he loved them to the
end.
2 During supper, the devil having
already put into the heart of Judas
Iscariot, Simon’s son, to betray him,
3 Jesus, knowing that the Father had
given all things into his hands, and that he
came from God and was going to God,
4 arose from supper, and laid aside his
outer garments. He took a towel and
wrapped a towel around his waist.

* **12:34** Isaiah 9:7; Daniel 2:44; See Isaiah 53:8 * **12:38** Isaiah 53:1 * **12:40** Isaiah 6:10 * **12:41** Isaiah 6:1

5 Then he poured water into the basin,
and began to wash the disciples' feet and
to wipe them with the towel that was
wrapped around him.
6 Then he came to Simon Peter. He said
to him, "Lord, do you wash my feet?"
7 Jesus answered him, "You don't know
what I am doing now, but you will
understand later."
8 Peter said to him, "You will never wash
my feet!"
Jesus answered him, "If I don't wash
you, you have no part with me."
9 Simon Peter said to him, "Lord, not my
feet only, but also my hands and my
head!"
10 Jesus said to him, "Someone who has
bathed only needs to have his feet
washed, but is completely clean. You are
clean, but not all of you."
11 For he knew him who would betray
him; therefore he said, "You are not all
clean."
12 So when he had washed their feet, put
his outer garment back on, and sat down
again, he said to them, "Do you know
what I have done to you?
13 You call me, 'Teacher' and 'Lord.' You
say so correctly, for so I am.
14 If I then, the Lord and the Teacher,
have washed your feet, you also ought to
wash one another's feet.
15 For I have given you an example, that
you should also do as I have done to you.
16 Most certainly I tell you, a servant is
not greater than his lord, neither is one
who is sent greater than he who sent him.
17 If you know these things, blessed are
you if you do them.
18 I don't speak concerning all of you. I
know whom I have chosen; but that the
Scripture may be fulfilled, 'He who eats
bread with me has lifted up his heel
against me.'*
19 From now on, I tell you before it
happens, that when it happens, you may
believe that I am he.
20 Most certainly I tell you, he who
receives whomever I send, receives me;
and he who receives me, receives him
who sent me."
21 When Jesus had said this, he was
troubled in spirit, and testified, "Most
certainly I tell you that one of you will
betray me."
22 The disciples looked at one another,
perplexed about whom he spoke.
23 One of his disciples, whom Jesus
loved, was at the table, leaning against
Jesus' chest.
24 Simon Peter therefore beckoned to
him, and said to him, "Tell us who it is of
whom he speaks."
25 He, leaning back, as he was, on Jesus'
chest, asked him, "Lord, who is it?"
26 Jesus therefore answered, "It is he to
whom I will give this piece of bread when
I have dipped it." So when he had dipped
the piece of bread, he gave it to Judas, the
son of Simon Iscariot.
27 After the piece of bread, then Satan
entered into him.
Then Jesus said to him, "What you do,
do quickly."
28 Now nobody at the table knew why
he said this to him.
29 For some thought, because Judas had
the money box, that Jesus said to him,
"Buy what things we need for the feast,"
or that he should give something to the
poor.
30 Therefore having received that
morsel, he went out immediately. It was
night.
31 When he had gone out, Jesus said,
"Now the Son of Man has been glorified,
and God has been glorified in him.
32 If God has been glorified in him, God
will also glorify him in himself, and he
will glorify him immediately.
33 Little children, I will be with you a
little while longer. You will seek me, and
as I said to the Jews, 'Where I am going,
you can't come,' so now I tell you.
34 A new commandment I give to you,
that you love one another. Just as I have
loved you, you also love one another.
35 By this everyone will know that you
are my disciples, if you have love for one
another."

* **13:18** Psalms 41:9

36 Simon Peter said to him, “Lord, where
are you going?”
Jesus answered, “Where I am going, you
can’t follow now, but you will follow
afterwards.”
37 Peter said to him, “Lord, why can’t I
follow you now? I will lay down my life
for you.”
38 Jesus answered him, “Will you lay
down your life for me? Most certainly I
tell you, the rooster won’t crow until you
have denied me three times.

14

1 “Don’t let your heart be troubled.
Believe in God. Believe also in me.
2 In my Father’s house are many homes.
If it weren’t so, I would have told you. I
am going to prepare a place for you.
3 If I go and prepare a place for you, I
will come again and will receive you to
myself; that where I am, you may be there
also.
4 You know where I go, and you know
the way.”
5 Thomas said to him, “Lord, we don’t
know where you are going. How can we
know the way?”
6 Jesus said to him, “I am the way, the
truth, and the life. No one comes to the
Father, except through me.
7 If you had known me, you would have
known my Father also. From now on, you
know him and have seen him.”
8 Philip said to him, “Lord, show us the
Father, and that will be enough for us.”
9 Jesus said to him, “Have I been with
you such a long time, and do you not
know me, Philip? He who has seen me has
seen the Father. How do you say, ‘Show us
the Father’?
10 Don’t you believe that I am in the
Father, and the Father in me? The words
that I tell you, I speak not from myself; but
the Father who lives in me does his works.
11 Believe me that I am in the Father,
and the Father in me; or else believe me
for the very works’ sake.
12 Most certainly I tell you, he who
believes in me, the works that I do, he will
do also; and he will do greater works than
these, because I am going to my Father.
13 Whatever you will ask in my name, I
will do it, that the Father may be glorified
in the Son.
14 If you will ask anything in my name, I
will do it.
15 If you love me, keep my
commandments.
16 I will pray to the Father, and he will
give you another Counselor, † that he may
be with you forever:
17 the Spirit of truth, whom the world
can’t receive, for it doesn’t see him and
doesn’t know him. You know him, for he
lives with you and will be in you.
18 I will not leave you orphans. I will
come to you.
19 Yet a little while, and the world will
see me no more; but you will see me.
Because I live, you will live also.
20 In that day you will know that I am in
my Father, and you in me, and I in you.
21 One who has my commandments and
keeps them, that person is one who loves
me. One who loves me will be loved by my
Father, and I will love him, and will reveal
myself to him.”
22 Judas (not Iscariot) said to him, “Lord,
what has happened that you are about to
reveal yourself to us, and not to the
world?”
23 Jesus answered him, “If a man loves
me, he will keep my word. My Father will
love him, and we will come to him and
make our home with him.
24 He who doesn’t love me doesn’t keep
my words. The word which you hear isn’t
mine, but the Father’s who sent me.
25 “I have said these things to you while
still living with you.
26 But the Counselor, the Holy Spirit,
whom the Father will send in my name,
will teach you all things, and will remind
you of all that I said to you.
27 Peace I leave with you. My peace I
give to you; not as the world gives, I give
to you. Don’t let your heart be troubled,
neither let it be fearful.

† **14:16** Greek παρακλητον: Counselor, Helper, Intercessor, Advocate, and Comforter.

28 You heard how I told you, ‘I am going
away, and I will come back to you.’ If you
loved me, you would have rejoiced
because I said ‘I am going to my Father;’
for the Father is greater than I.
29 Now I have told you before it happens
so that when it happens, you may believe.
30 I will no more speak much with you,
for the prince of the world comes, and he
has nothing in me.
31 But that the world may know that I
love the Father, and as the Father
commanded me, even so I do. Arise, let’s
go from here.

15

1 “I am the true vine, and my Father is
the farmer.
2 Every branch in me that doesn’t bear
fruit, he takes away. Every branch that
bears fruit, he prunes, that it may bear
more fruit.
3 You are already pruned clean because
of the word which I have spoken to you.
4 Remain in me, and I in you. As the
branch can’t bear fruit by itself unless it
remains in the vine, so neither can you,
unless you remain in me.
5 I am the vine. You are the branches.
He who remains in me and I in him bears
much fruit, for apart from me you can do
nothing.
6 If a man doesn’t remain in me, he is
thrown out as a branch and is withered;
and they gather them, throw them into
the fire, and they are burned.
7 If you remain in me, and my words
remain in you, you will ask whatever you
desire, and it will be done for you.
8 “In this my Father is glorified, that you
bear much fruit; and so you will be my
disciples.
9 Even as the Father has loved me, I also
have loved you. Remain in my love.
10 If you keep my commandments, you
will remain in my love, even as I have
kept my Father’s commandments and
remain in his love.
11 I have spoken these things to you, that
my joy may remain in you, and that your
joy may be made full.
12 “This is my commandment, that you
love one another, even as I have loved
you.
13 Greater love has no one than this, that
someone lay down his life for his friends.
14 You are my friends if you do whatever
I command you.
15 No longer do I call you servants, for
the servant doesn’t know what his lord
does. But I have called you friends, for
everything that I heard from my Father, I
have made known to you.
16 You didn’t choose me, but I chose you
and appointed you, that you should go
and bear fruit, and that your fruit should
remain; that whatever you will ask of the
Father in my name, he may give it to you.
17 “I command these things to you, that
you may love one another.
18 If the world hates you, you know that
it has hated me before it hated you.
19 If you were of the world, the world
would love its own. But because you are
not of the world, since I chose you out of
the world, therefore the world hates you.
20 Remember the word that I said to
you: ‘A servant is not greater than his
lord.’* If they persecuted me, they will
also persecute you. If they kept my word,
they will also keep yours.
21 But they will do all these things to you
for my name’s sake, because they don’t
know him who sent me.
22 If I had not come and spoken to them,
they would not have had sin; but now
they have no excuse for their sin.
23 He who hates me, hates my Father
also.
24 If I hadn’t done among them the
works which no one else did, they
wouldn’t have had sin. But now they have
seen and also hated both me and my
Father.
25 But this happened so that the word
may be fulfilled which was written in

* **15:20** John 13:16 * **15:25** Psalms 35:19; 69:4 † **15:26** Greek Parakletos: Counselor, Helper, Advocate, Intercessor, and Comforter.

their law, ‘They hated me without a cause.’*
26 “When the Counselor† has come, whom I will send to you from the Father, the Spirit of truth, who proceeds from the Father, he will testify about me.
27 You will also testify, because you have been with me from the beginning.

16

1 “I have said these things to you so that you wouldn’t be caused to stumble.
2 They will put you out of the synagogues. Yes, the time is coming that whoever kills you will think that he offers service to God.
3 They will do these things† because they have not known the Father nor me.
4 But I have told you these things so that when the time comes, you may remember that I told you about them. I didn’t tell you these things from the beginning, because I was with you.
5 But now I am going to him who sent me, and none of you asks me, ‘Where are you going?’
6 But because I have told you these things, sorrow has filled your heart.
7 Nevertheless I tell you the truth: It is to your advantage that I go away; for if I don’t go away, the Counselor won’t come to you. But if I go, I will send him to you.
8 When he has come, he will convict the world about sin, about righteousness, and about judgment;
9 about sin, because they don’t believe in me;
10 about righteousness, because I am going to my Father, and you won’t see me any more;
11 about judgment, because the prince of this world has been judged.
12 “I still have many things to tell you, but you can’t bear them now.
13 However, when he, the Spirit of truth, has come, he will guide you into all truth, for he will not speak from himself; but whatever he hears, he will speak. He will declare to you things that are coming.
14 He will glorify me, for he will take from what is mine and will declare it to you.
15 All things that the Father has are mine; therefore I said that he takes‡ of mine and will declare it to you.
16 “A little while, and you will not see me. Again a little while, and you will see me.”
17 Some of his disciples therefore said to one another, “What is this that he says to us, ‘A little while, and you won’t see me, and again a little while, and you will see me;’ and, ‘Because I go to the Father’?”
18 They said therefore, “What is this that he says, ‘A little while’? We don’t know what he is saying.”
19 Therefore Jesus perceived that they wanted to ask him, and he said to them, “Do you inquire among yourselves concerning this, that I said, ‘A little while, and you won’t see me, and again a little while, and you will see me’?
20 Most certainly I tell you that you will weep and lament, but the world will rejoice. You will be sorrowful, but your sorrow will be turned into joy.
21 A woman, when she gives birth, has sorrow because her time has come. But when she has delivered the child, she doesn’t remember the anguish any more, for the joy that a human being is born into the world.
22 Therefore you now have sorrow, but I will see you again, and your heart will rejoice, and no one will take your joy away from you.
23 “In that day you will ask me no questions. Most certainly I tell you, whatever you may ask of the Father in my name, he will give it to you.
24 Until now, you have asked nothing in my name. Ask, and you will receive, that your joy may be made full.
25 “I have spoken these things to you in figures of speech. But the time is coming when I will no more speak to you in figures of speech, but will tell you plainly about the Father.

† **16:3** TR adds “to you” ‡ **16:15** TR reads “will take” instead of “takes”

26 In that day you will ask in my name;
and I don't say to you that I will pray to the
Father for you,
27 for the Father himself loves you,
because you have loved me, and have
believed that I came from God.
28 I came from the Father and have
come into the world. Again, I leave the
world and go to the Father."
29 His disciples said to him, "Behold,
now you are speaking plainly, and using
no figures of speech.
30 Now we know that you know all
things, and don't need for anyone to
question you. By this we believe that you
came from God."
31 Jesus answered them, "Do you now
believe?
32 Behold, the time is coming, yes, and
has now come, that you will be scattered,
everyone to his own place, and you will
leave me alone. Yet I am not alone,
because the Father is with me.
33 I have told you these things, that in
me you may have peace. In the world you
have trouble; but cheer up! I have
overcome the world."

17

1 Jesus said these things, then lifting up
his eyes to heaven, he said, "Father, the
time has come. Glorify your Son, that
your Son may also glorify you;
2 even as you gave him authority over
all flesh, so he will give eternal life to all
whom you have given him.
3 This is eternal life, that they should
know you, the only true God, and him
whom you sent, Jesus Christ.
4 I glorified you on the earth. I have
accomplished the work which you have
given me to do.
5 Now, Father, glorify me with your own
self with the glory which I had with you
before the world existed.
6 "I revealed your name to the people
whom you have given me out of the
world. They were yours, and you have
given them to me. They have kept your
word.
7 Now they have known that all things
whatever you have given me are from
you,
8 for the words which you have given
me I have given to them; and they
received them, and knew for sure that I
came from you. They have believed that
you sent me.
9 I pray for them. I don't pray for the
world, but for those whom you have given
me, for they are yours.
10 All things that are mine are yours,
and yours are mine, and I am glorified in
them.
11 I am no more in the world, but these
are in the world, and I am coming to you.
Holy Father, keep them through your
name which you have given me, that they
may be one, even as we are.
12 While I was with them in the world, I
kept them in your name. I have kept those
whom you have given me. None of them
is lost except the son of destruction, that
the Scripture might be fulfilled.
13 But now I come to you, and I say these
things in the world, that they may have
my joy made full in themselves.
14 I have given them your word. The
world hated them because they are not of
the world, even as I am not of the world.
15 I pray not that you would take them
from the world, but that you would keep
them from the evil one.
16 They are not of the world, even as I
am not of the world.
17 Sanctify them in your truth. Your
word is truth.*
18 As you sent me into the world, even
so I have sent them into the world.
19 For their sakes I sanctify myself, that
they themselves also may be sanctified in
truth.
20 "Not for these only do I pray, but for
those also who will believe in me through
their word,
21 that they may all be one; even as you,
Father, are in me, and I in you, that they
also may be one in us; that the world may
believe that you sent me.
22 The glory which you have given me, I
have given to them, that they may be one,

* **17:17** Psalms 119:142

even as we are one,
23 I in them, and you in me, that they
may be perfected into one, that the world
may know that you sent me and loved
them, even as you loved me.
24 Father, I desire that they also whom
you have given me be with me where I
am, that they may see my glory which you
have given me, for you loved me before
the foundation of the world.
25 Righteous Father, the world hasn't
known you, but I knew you; and these
knew that you sent me.
26 I made known to them your name,
and will make it known; that the love with
which you loved me may be in them, and I
in them."

18

1 When Jesus had spoken these words,
he went out with his disciples over the
brook Kidron, where there was a garden,
into which he and his disciples entered.
2 Now Judas, who betrayed him, also
knew the place, for Jesus often met there
with his disciples.
3 Judas then, having taken a detachment
of soldiers and officers from the chief
priests and the Pharisees, came there with
lanterns, torches, and weapons.
4 Jesus therefore, knowing all the things
that were happening to him, went out and
said to them, "Who are you looking for?"
5 They answered him, "Jesus of
Nazareth."
Jesus said to them, "I am he."
Judas also, who betrayed him, was
standing with them.
6 When therefore he said to them, "I am
he," they went backward and fell to the
ground.
7 Again therefore he asked them, "Who
are you looking for?"
They said, "Jesus of Nazareth."
8 Jesus answered, "I told you that I am
he. If therefore you seek me, let these go
their way,"
9 that the word might be fulfilled which
he spoke, "Of those whom you have given
me, I have lost none."*

* **18:9** John 6:39

10 Simon Peter therefore, having a
sword, drew it, struck the high priest's
servant, and cut off his right ear. The
servant's name was Malchus.
11 Jesus therefore said to Peter, "Put the
sword into its sheath. The cup which the
Father has given me, shall I not surely
drink it?"
12 So the detachment, the commanding
officer, and the officers of the Jews seized
Jesus and bound him,
13 and led him to Annas first, for he was
father-in-law to Caiaphas, who was high
priest that year.
14 Now it was Caiaphas who advised the
Jews that it was expedient that one man
should perish for the people.
15 Simon Peter followed Jesus, as did
another disciple. Now that disciple was
known to the high priest, and entered in
with Jesus into the court of the high priest;
16 but Peter was standing at the door
outside. So the other disciple, who was
known to the high priest, went out and
spoke to her who kept the door, and
brought in Peter.
17 Then the maid who kept the door said
to Peter, "Are you also one of this man's
disciples?"
He said, "I am not."
18 Now the servants and the officers
were standing there, having made a fire
of coals, for it was cold. They were
warming themselves. Peter was with
them, standing and warming himself.
19 The high priest therefore asked Jesus
about his disciples and about his teaching.
20 Jesus answered him, "I spoke openly
to the world. I always taught in
synagogues and in the temple, where the
Jews always meet. I said nothing in secret.
21 Why do you ask me? Ask those who
have heard me what I said to them.
Behold, they know the things which I
said."
22 When he had said this, one of the
officers standing by slapped Jesus with his
hand, saying, "Do you answer the high
priest like that?"

23 Jesus answered him, “If I have spoken evil, testify of the evil; but if well, why do you beat me?”

24 Annas sent him bound to Caiaphas, the high priest.

25 Now Simon Peter was standing and warming himself. They said therefore to him, “You aren’t also one of his disciples, are you?”

He denied it and said, “I am not.”

26 One of the servants of the high priest, being a relative of him whose ear Peter had cut off, said, “Didn’t I see you in the garden with him?”

27 Peter therefore denied it again, and immediately the rooster crowed.

28 They led Jesus therefore from Caiaphas into the Praetorium. It was early, and they themselves didn’t enter into the Praetorium, that they might not be defiled, but might eat the Passover.

29 Pilate therefore went out to them and said, “What accusation do you bring against this man?”

30 They answered him, “If this man weren’t an evildoer, we wouldn’t have delivered him up to you.”

31 Pilate therefore said to them, “Take him yourselves, and judge him according to your law.”

Therefore the Jews said to him, “It is illegal for us to put anyone to death,”

32 that the word of Jesus might be fulfilled, which he spoke, signifying by what kind of death he should die.

33 Pilate therefore entered again into the Praetorium, called Jesus, and said to him, “Are you the King of the Jews?”

34 Jesus answered him, “Do you say this by yourself, or did others tell you about me?”

35 Pilate answered, “I’m not a Jew, am I? Your own nation and the chief priests delivered you to me. What have you done?”

36 Jesus answered, “My Kingdom is not of this world. If my Kingdom were of this world, then my servants would fight, that I wouldn’t be delivered to the Jews. But now my Kingdom is not from here.”

37 Pilate therefore said to him, “Are you a king then?”

Jesus answered, “You say that I am a king. For this reason I have been born, and for this reason I have come into the world, that I should testify to the truth. Everyone who is of the truth listens to my voice.”

38 Pilate said to him, “What is truth?”

When he had said this, he went out again to the Jews, and said to them, “I find no basis for a charge against him.

39 But you have a custom that I should release someone to you at the Passover. Therefore, do you want me to release to you the King of the Jews?”

40 Then they all shouted again, saying, “Not this man, but Barabbas!” Now Barabbas was a robber.

19

1 So Pilate then took Jesus and flogged him.

2 The soldiers twisted thorns into a crown and put it on his head, and dressed him in a purple garment.

3 They kept saying, “Hail, King of the Jews!” and they kept slapping him.

4 Then Pilate went out again, and said to them, “Behold, I bring him out to you, that you may know that I find no basis for a charge against him.”

5 Jesus therefore came out, wearing the crown of thorns and the purple garment. Pilate said to them, “Behold, the man!”

6 When therefore the chief priests and the officers saw him, they shouted, saying, “Crucify! Crucify!”

Pilate said to them, “Take him yourselves and crucify him, for I find no basis for a charge against him.”

7 The Jews answered him, “We have a law, and by our law he ought to die, because he made himself the Son of God.”

8 When therefore Pilate heard this saying, he was more afraid.

9 He entered into the Praetorium again, and said to Jesus, “Where are you from?” But Jesus gave him no answer.

10 Pilate therefore said to him, “Aren’t you speaking to me? Don’t you know that

I have power to release you and have
power to crucify you?"
11 Jesus answered, "You would have no
power at all against me, unless it were
given to you from above. Therefore he
who delivered me to you has greater sin."
12 At this, Pilate was seeking to release
him, but the Jews cried out, saying, "If you
release this man, you aren't Caesar's
friend! Everyone who makes himself a
king speaks against Caesar!"
13 When Pilate therefore heard these
words, he brought Jesus out and sat down
on the judgment seat at a place called "The
Pavement", but in Hebrew, "Gabbatha."
14 Now it was the Preparation Day of the
Passover, at about the sixth hour.† He said
to the Jews, "Behold, your King!"
15 They cried out, "Away with him!
Away with him! Crucify him!"
Pilate said to them, "Shall I crucify your
King?"
The chief priests answered, "We have
no king but Caesar!"
16 So then he delivered him to them to
be crucified. So they took Jesus and led
him away.
17 He went out, bearing his cross, to the
place called "The Place of a Skull", which
is called in Hebrew, "Golgotha",
18 where they crucified him, and with
him two others, on either side one, and
Jesus in the middle.
19 Pilate wrote a title also, and put it on
the cross. There was written, "JESUS OF
NAZARETH, THE KING OF THE JEWS."
20 Therefore many of the Jews read this
title, for the place where Jesus was
crucified was near the city; and it was
written in Hebrew, in Latin, and in Greek.
21 The chief priests of the Jews therefore
said to Pilate, "Don't write, 'The King of
the Jews,' but, 'he said, "I am King of the
Jews." ' "
22 Pilate answered, "What I have
written, I have written."
23 Then the soldiers, when they had
crucified Jesus, took his garments and
made four parts, to every soldier a part;
and also the tunic. Now the tunic was
without seam, woven from the top
throughout.
24 Then they said to one another, "Let's
not tear it, but cast lots for it to decide
whose it will be," that the Scripture might
be fulfilled, which says,

"They parted my garments among them.
They cast lots for my clothing."*

Therefore the soldiers did these things.
25 But standing by Jesus' cross were his
mother, his mother's sister, Mary the wife
of Clopas, and Mary Magdalene.
26 Therefore when Jesus saw his
mother, and the disciple whom he loved
standing there, he said to his mother,
"Woman, behold, your son!"
27 Then he said to the disciple, "Behold,
your mother!" From that hour, the
disciple took her to his own home.
28 After this, Jesus, seeing‡ that all things
were now finished, that the Scripture
might be fulfilled, said, "I am thirsty!"
29 Now a vessel full of vinegar was set
there; so they put a sponge full of the
vinegar on hyssop, and held it at his
mouth.
30 When Jesus therefore had received
the vinegar, he said, "It is finished!" Then
he bowed his head and gave up his spirit.
31 Therefore the Jews, because it was the
Preparation Day, so that the bodies
wouldn't remain on the cross on the
Sabbath (for that Sabbath was a special
one), asked of Pilate that their legs might
be broken and that they might be taken
away.
32 Therefore the soldiers came and
broke the legs of the first and of the other
who was crucified with him;
33 but when they came to Jesus and saw
that he was already dead, they didn't
break his legs.
34 However, one of the soldiers pierced
his side with a spear, and immediately
blood and water came out.

† **19:14** "the sixth hour" would have been 6:00 a.m. according to the Roman timekeeping system, or noon for the Jewish timekeeping system in use, then. * **19:24** Psalms 22:18 ‡ **19:28** NU, TR read "knowing" instead of "seeing"

35 He who has seen has testified, and his
testimony is true. He knows that he tells
the truth, that you may believe.
36 For these things happened that the
Scripture might be fulfilled, “A bone of
him will not be broken.”*
37 Again another Scripture says, “They
will look on him whom they pierced.”*
38 After these things, Joseph of
Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but
secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of
Pilate that he might take away Jesus’ body.
Pilate gave him permission. He came
therefore and took away his body.
39 Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus
by night, also came bringing a mixture of
myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman
pounds.§
40 So they took Jesus’ body, and bound it
in linen cloths with the spices, as the
custom of the Jews is to bury.
41 Now in the place where he was
crucified there was a garden. In the
garden was a new tomb in which no man
had ever yet been laid.
42 Then, because of the Jews’
Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at
hand), they laid Jesus there.

20

1 Now on the first day of the week, Mary
Magdalene went early, while it was still
dark, to the tomb, and saw that the stone
had been taken away from the tomb.
2 Therefore she ran and came to Simon
Peter and to the other disciple whom
Jesus loved, and said to them, “They have
taken away the Lord out of the tomb, and
we don’t know where they have laid him!”
3 Therefore Peter and the other disciple
went out, and they went toward the tomb.
4 They both ran together. The other
disciple outran Peter and came to the
tomb first.
5 Stooping and looking in, he saw the
linen cloths lying there; yet he didn’t enter
in.
6 Then Simon Peter came, following
him, and entered into the tomb. He saw
the linen cloths lying,
7 and the cloth that had been on his
head, not lying with the linen cloths, but
rolled up in a place by itself.
8 So then the other disciple who came
first to the tomb also entered in, and he
saw and believed.
9 For as yet they didn’t know the
Scripture, that he must rise from the dead.
10 So the disciples went away again to
their own homes.
11 But Mary was standing outside at the
tomb weeping. So as she wept, she
stooped and looked into the tomb,
12 and she saw two angels in white
sitting, one at the head and one at the feet,
where the body of Jesus had lain.
13 They asked her, “Woman, why are
you weeping?”
She said to them, “Because they have
taken away my Lord, and I don’t know
where they have laid him.”
14 When she had said this, she turned
around and saw Jesus standing, and didn’t
know that it was Jesus.
15 Jesus said to her, “Woman, why are
you weeping? Who are you looking for?”
She, supposing him to be the gardener,
said to him, “Sir, if you have carried him
away, tell me where you have laid him,
and I will take him away.”
16 Jesus said to her, “Mary.”
She turned and said to him, “Rabboni!”†
which is to say, “Teacher!”‡
17 Jesus said to her, “Don’t hold me, for I
haven’t yet ascended to my Father; but go
to my brothers and tell them, ‘I am
ascending to my Father and your Father,
to my God and your God.’ ”
18 Mary Magdalene came and told the
disciples that she had seen the Lord, and
that he had said these things to her.
19 When therefore it was evening on
that day, the first day of the week, and
when the doors were locked where the
disciples were assembled, for fear of the

* **19:36** Exodus 12:46; Numbers 9:12; Psalms 34:20
* **19:37** Zechariah 12:10
§ **19:39** 100 Roman pounds of 12 ounces each, or about 72 pounds, or 33 Kilograms.
† **20:16** Rabboni is a transliteration of the Hebrew word for “great teacher.”
‡ **20:16** or, Master

Jews, Jesus came and stood in the middle and said to them, “Peace be to you.”
20 When he had said this, he showed them his hands and his side. The disciples therefore were glad when they saw the Lord.
21 Jesus therefore said to them again, “Peace be to you. As the Father has sent me, even so I send you.”
22 When he had said this, he breathed on them, and said to them, “Receive the Holy Spirit!
23 If you forgive anyone’s sins, they have been forgiven them. If you retain anyone’s sins, they have been retained.”
24 But Thomas, one of the twelve, called Didymus,§ wasn’t with them when Jesus came.
25 The other disciples therefore said to him, “We have seen the Lord!”
But he said to them, “Unless I see in his hands the print of the nails, put my finger into the print of the nails, and put my hand into his side, I will not believe.”
26 After eight days, again his disciples were inside and Thomas was with them. Jesus came, the doors being locked, and stood in the middle, and said, “Peace be to you.”
27 Then he said to Thomas, “Reach here your finger, and see my hands. Reach here your hand, and put it into my side. Don’t be unbelieving, but believing.”
28 Thomas answered him, “My Lord and my God!”
29 Jesus said to him, “Because you have seen me,† you have believed. Blessed are those who have not seen and have believed.”
30 Therefore Jesus did many other signs in the presence of his disciples, which are not written in this book;
31 but these are written that you may believe that Jesus is the Christ, the Son of God, and that believing you may have life in his name.

21

1 After these things, Jesus revealed himself again to the disciples at the sea of Tiberias. He revealed himself this way.
2 Simon Peter, Thomas called Didymus,† Nathanael of Cana in Galilee, and the sons of Zebedee, and two others of his disciples were together.
3 Simon Peter said to them, “I’m going fishing.”
They told him, “We are also coming with you.” They immediately went out and entered into the boat. That night, they caught nothing.
4 But when day had already come, Jesus stood on the beach; yet the disciples didn’t know that it was Jesus.
5 Jesus therefore said to them, “Children, have you anything to eat?”
They answered him, “No.”
6 He said to them, “Cast the net on the right side of the boat, and you will find some.”
They cast it therefore, and now they weren’t able to draw it in for the multitude of fish.
7 That disciple therefore whom Jesus loved said to Peter, “It’s the Lord!”
So when Simon Peter heard that it was the Lord, he wrapped his coat around himself (for he was naked), and threw himself into the sea.
8 But the other disciples came in the little boat (for they were not far from the land, but about two hundred cubits‡ away), dragging the net full of fish.
9 So when they got out on the land, they saw a fire of coals there, with fish and bread laid on it.
10 Jesus said to them, “Bring some of the fish which you have just caught.”
11 Simon Peter went up, and drew the net to land, full of one hundred fifty-three great fish. Even though there were so many, the net wasn’t torn.
12 Jesus said to them, “Come and eat breakfast!”
None of the disciples dared inquire of him, “Who are you?” knowing that it was the Lord.
13 Then Jesus came and took the bread, gave it to them, and the fish likewise.

§ **20:24** or, Twin † **20:29** TR adds “Thomas,” † **21:2** or, Twin ‡ **21:8** 200 cubits is about 100 yards or about 91 meters

14 This is now the third time that Jesus
was revealed to his disciples after he had
risen from the dead.
15 So when they had eaten their
breakfast, Jesus said to Simon Peter,
"Simon, son of Jonah, do you love me
more than these?"
He said to him, "Yes, Lord; you know
that I have affection for you."
He said to him, "Feed my lambs."
16 He said to him again a second time,
"Simon, son of Jonah, do you love me?"
He said to him, "Yes, Lord; you know
that I have affection for you."
He said to him, "Tend my sheep."
17 He said to him the third time, "Simon,
son of Jonah, do you have affection for
me?"
Peter was grieved because he asked him
the third time, "Do you have affection for
me?" He said to him, "Lord, you know
everything. You know that I have
affection for you."
Jesus said to him, "Feed my sheep.
18 Most certainly I tell you, when you
were young, you dressed yourself and
walked where you wanted to. But when
you are old, you will stretch out your
hands, and another will dress you and
carry you where you don't want to go."
19 Now he said this, signifying by what
kind of death he would glorify God. When
he had said this, he said to him, "Follow
me."
20 Then Peter, turning around, saw a
disciple following. This was the disciple
whom Jesus loved, the one who had also
leaned on Jesus' chest at the supper and
asked, "Lord, who is going to betray you?"
21 Peter, seeing him, said to Jesus, "Lord,
what about this man?"
22 Jesus said to him, "If I desire that he
stay until I come, what is that to you? You
follow me."
23 This saying therefore went out among
the brothers§ that this disciple wouldn't
die. Yet Jesus didn't say to him that he
wouldn't die, but, "If I desire that he stay
until I come, what is that to you?"
24 This is the disciple who testifies about
these things, and wrote these things. We
know that his witness is true.
25 There are also many other things
which Jesus did, which if they would all
be written, I suppose that even the world
itself wouldn't have room for the books
that would be written.

§ **21:23** The word for "brothers" here may be also correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

The Acts of the Apostles

1 The first book I wrote, Theophilus,
concerned all that Jesus began both to do
and to teach,
2 until the day in which he was received
up, after he had given commandment
through the Holy Spirit to the apostles
whom he had chosen.
3 To these he also showed himself alive
after he suffered, by many proofs,
appearing to them over a period of forty
days and speaking about God's Kingdom.
4 Being assembled together with them,
he commanded them, "Don't depart from
Jerusalem, but wait for the promise of the
Father, which you heard from me.
5 For John indeed baptized in water, but
you will be baptized in the Holy Spirit not
many days from now."
6 Therefore, when they had come
together, they asked him, "Lord, are you
now restoring the kingdom to Israel?"
7 He said to them, "It isn't for you to
know times or seasons which the Father
has set within his own authority.
8 But you will receive power when the
Holy Spirit has come upon you. You will
be witnesses to me in Jerusalem, in all
Judea and Samaria, and to the uttermost
parts of the earth."
9 When he had said these things, as they
were looking, he was taken up, and a
cloud received him out of their sight.
10 While they were looking steadfastly
into the sky as he went, behold,† two men
stood by them in white clothing,
11 who also said, "You men of Galilee,
why do you stand looking into the sky?
This Jesus, who was received up from you
into the sky, will come back in the same
way as you saw him going into the sky."
12 Then they returned to Jerusalem from
the mountain called Olivet, which is near
Jerusalem, a Sabbath day's journey away.
13 When they had come in, they went up
into the upper room where they were
staying, that is Peter, John, James,
Andrew, Philip, Thomas, Bartholomew,
Matthew, James the son of Alphaeus,
Simon the Zealot, and Judas the son of
James.
14 All these with one accord continued
steadfastly in prayer and supplication,
along with the women and Mary the
mother of Jesus, and with his brothers.
15 In these days, Peter stood up in the
middle of the disciples (and the number of
names was about one hundred twenty),
and said,
16 "Brothers, it was necessary that this
Scripture should be fulfilled, which the
Holy Spirit spoke before by the mouth of
David concerning Judas, who was guide to
those who took Jesus.
17 For he was counted with us, and
received his portion in this ministry.
18 Now this man obtained a field with
the reward for his wickedness; and falling
headlong, his body burst open and all his
intestines gushed out.
19 It became known to everyone who
lived in Jerusalem that in their language
that field was called 'Akeldama,' that is,
'The field of blood.'
20 For it is written in the book of Psalms,
'Let his habitation be made desolate.
Let no one dwell in it;'*
and,
'Let another take his office.'*
21 "Of the men therefore who have
accompanied us all the time that the Lord
Jesus went in and out among us,
22 beginning from the baptism of John
to the day that he was received up from
us, of these one must become a witness
with us of his resurrection."
23 They put forward two: Joseph called
Barsabbas, who was also called Justus,
and Matthias.
24 They prayed and said, "You, Lord,
who know the hearts of all men, show
which one of these two you have chosen
25 to take part in this ministry and
apostleship from which Judas fell away,
that he might go to his own place."

† **1:10** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
* **1:20** Psalms 69:25 * **1:20** Psalms 109:8

26 They drew lots for them, and the lot
fell on Matthias; and he was counted with
the eleven apostles.

2

1 Now when the day of Pentecost had
come, they were all with one accord in
one place.
2 Suddenly there came from the sky a
sound like the rushing of a mighty wind,
and it filled all the house where they were
sitting.
3 Tongues like fire appeared and were
distributed to them, and one sat on each
of them.
4 They were all filled with the Holy
Spirit and began to speak with other
languages, as the Spirit gave them the
ability to speak.
5 Now there were dwelling in Jerusalem
Jews, devout men, from every nation
under the sky.
6 When this sound was heard, the
multitude came together and were
bewildered, because everyone heard
them speaking in his own language.
7 They were all amazed and marveled,
saying to one another, "Behold, aren't all
these who speak Galileans?
8 How do we hear, everyone in our own
native language?
9 Parthians, Medes, Elamites, and
people from Mesopotamia, Judea,
Cappadocia, Pontus, Asia,
10 Phrygia, Pamphylia, Egypt, the parts
of Libya around Cyrene, visitors from
Rome, both Jews and proselytes,
11 Cretans and Arabians—we hear them
speaking in our languages the mighty
works of God!"
12 They were all amazed and were
perplexed, saying to one another, "What
does this mean?"
13 Others, mocking, said, "They are filled
with new wine."
14 But Peter, standing up with the
eleven, lifted up his voice and spoke out to
them, "You men of Judea and all you who
dwell at Jerusalem, let this be known to
you, and listen to my words.
15 For these aren't drunken, as you
suppose, seeing it is only the third hour of
the day.†
16 But this is what has been spoken
through the prophet Joel:
17 'It will be in the last days, says God,
that I will pour out my Spirit on all
flesh.
Your sons and your daughters will
prophesy.
Your young men will see visions.
Your old men will dream dreams.
18 Yes, and on my servants and on my
handmaidens in those days,
I will pour out my Spirit, and they will
prophesy.
19 I will show wonders in the sky above,
and signs on the earth beneath:
blood, and fire, and billows of smoke.
20 The sun will be turned into darkness,
and the moon into blood,
before the great and glorious day of
the Lord comes.
21 It will be that whoever will call on the
name of the Lord will be saved.'*
22 "Men of Israel, hear these words!
Jesus of Nazareth, a man approved by God
to you by mighty works and wonders and
signs which God did by him among you,
even as you yourselves know,
23 him, being delivered up by the
determined counsel and foreknowledge
of God, you have taken by the hand of
lawless men, crucified and killed;
24 whom God raised up, having freed
him from the agony of death, because it
was not possible that he should be held by
it.
25 For David says concerning him,
'I saw the Lord always before my face,
for he is on my right hand, that I
should not be moved.
26 Therefore my heart was glad, and my
tongue rejoiced.
Moreover my flesh also will dwell in
hope,
27 because you will not leave my soul in
Hades,‡
neither will you allow your Holy One
to see decay.

† **2:15** about 9:00 a.m. * **2:21** Joel 2:28-32 ‡ **2:27** or, Hell

28 You made known to me the ways of life.
You will make me full of gladness
with your presence.’*

29 “Brothers, I may tell you freely of the patriarch David, that he both died and was buried, and his tomb is with us to this day.
30 Therefore, being a prophet, and knowing that God had sworn with an oath to him that of the fruit of his body, according to the flesh, he would raise up the Christ§ to sit on his throne,
31 he foreseeing this, spoke about the resurrection of the Christ, that his soul wasn’t left in Hades,† and his flesh didn’t see decay.
32 This Jesus God raised up, to which we all are witnesses.
33 Being therefore exalted by the right hand of God, and having received from the Father the promise of the Holy Spirit, he has poured out this which you now see and hear.
34 For David didn’t ascend into the heavens, but he says himself,
‘The Lord said to my Lord, “Sit by my right hand
35 until I make your enemies a
footstool for your feet.” ’*

36 “Let all the house of Israel therefore know certainly that God has made him both Lord and Christ, this Jesus whom you crucified.”
37 Now when they heard this, they were cut to the heart, and said to Peter and the rest of the apostles, “Brothers, what shall we do?”
38 Peter said to them, “Repent and be baptized, every one of you, in the name of Jesus Christ for the forgiveness of sins, and you will receive the gift of the Holy Spirit.
39 For the promise is to you and to your children, and to all who are far off, even as many as the Lord our God will call to himself.”
40 With many other words he testified and exhorted them, saying, “Save yourselves from this crooked generation!”
41 Then those who gladly received his word were baptized. There were added that day about three thousand souls.
42 They continued steadfastly in the apostles’ teaching and fellowship, in the breaking of bread, and prayer.
43 Fear came on every soul, and many wonders and signs were done through the apostles.
44 All who believed were together, and had all things in common.
45 They sold their possessions and goods, and distributed them to all, according as anyone had need.
46 Day by day, continuing steadfastly with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread at home, they took their food with gladness and singleness of heart,
47 praising God and having favor with all the people. The Lord added to the assembly day by day those who were being saved.

3

1 Peter and John were going up into the temple at the hour of prayer, the ninth hour.†
2 A certain man who was lame from his mother’s womb was being carried, whom they laid daily at the door of the temple which is called Beautiful, to ask gifts for the needy of those who entered into the temple.
3 Seeing Peter and John about to go into the temple, he asked to receive gifts for the needy.
4 Peter, fastening his eyes on him, with John, said, “Look at us.”
5 He listened to them, expecting to receive something from them.
6 But Peter said, “I have no silver or gold, but what I have, that I give you. In the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth, get up and walk!”
7 He took him by the right hand and raised him up. Immediately his feet and his ankle bones received strength.

* **2:28** Psalms 16:8-11 § **2:30** “Christ” means “Anointed One”. † **2:31** or, Hell * **2:35** Psalms 110:1 † **3:1** 3:00 p.m.

8 Leaping up, he stood and began to
walk. He entered with them into the
temple, walking, leaping, and praising
God.
9 All the people saw him walking and
praising God.
10 They recognized him, that it was he
who used to sit begging for gifts for the
needy at the Beautiful Gate of the temple.
They were filled with wonder and
amazement at what had happened to him.
11 As the lame man who was healed held
on to Peter and John, all the people ran
together to them in the porch that is called
Solomon's, greatly wondering.

12 When Peter saw it, he responded to
the people, "You men of Israel, why do you
marvel at this man? Why do you fasten
your eyes on us, as though by our own
power or godliness we had made him
walk?
13 The God of Abraham, Isaac, and
Jacob, the God of our fathers, has glorified
his Servant Jesus, whom you delivered up
and denied in the presence of Pilate, when
he had determined to release him.
14 But you denied the Holy and
Righteous One and asked for a murderer
to be granted to you,
15 and killed the Prince of life, whom
God raised from the dead, to which we are
witnesses.
16 By faith in his name, his name has
made this man strong, whom you see and
know. Yes, the faith which is through him
has given him this perfect soundness in
the presence of you all.

17 "Now, brothers,‡ I know that you did
this in ignorance, as did also your rulers.
18 But the things which God announced
by the mouth of all his prophets, that
Christ should suffer, he thus fulfilled.

19 "Repent therefore, and turn again,
that your sins may be blotted out, so that
there may come times of refreshing from
the presence of the Lord,
20 and that he may send Christ Jesus,
who was ordained for you before,
21 whom heaven must receive until the
times of restoration of all things, which
God spoke long ago by the mouth of his
holy prophets.
22 For Moses indeed said to the fathers,
'The Lord God will raise up a prophet for
you from among your brothers, like me.
You shall listen to him in all things
whatever he says to you.
23 It will be that every soul that will not
listen to that prophet will be utterly
destroyed from among the people.'*
24 Yes, and all the prophets from Samuel
and those who followed after, as many as
have spoken, also told of these days.
25 You are the children of the prophets,
and of the covenant which God made with
our fathers, saying to Abraham, 'All the
families of the earth will be blessed
through your offspring.'§*
26 God, having raised up his servant
Jesus, sent him to you first to bless you, in
turning away every one of you from your
wickedness."

4

1 As they spoke to the people, the priests
and the captain of the temple and the
Sadducees came to them,
2 being upset because they taught the
people and proclaimed in Jesus the
resurrection from the dead.
3 They laid hands on them, and put
them in custody until the next day, for it
was now evening.
4 But many of those who heard the word
believed, and the number of the men
came to be about five thousand.
5 In the morning, their rulers, elders,
and scribes were gathered together in
Jerusalem.
6 Annas the high priest was there, with
Caiaphas, John, Alexander, and as many
as were relatives of the high priest.
7 When they had stood Peter and John in
the middle of them, they inquired, "By
what power, or in what name, have you
done this?"

‡ **3:17** The word for "brothers" here may be also correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **3:23** Deuteronomy 18:15,18-19 § **3:25** or, seed * **3:25** Genesis 22:18; 26:4

8 Then Peter, filled with the Holy Spirit,
said to them, “You rulers of the people and
elders of Israel,
9 if we are examined today concerning a
good deed done to a crippled man, by
what means this man has been healed,
10 may it be known to you all, and to all
the people of Israel, that in the name of
Jesus Christ of Nazareth, whom you
crucified, whom God raised from the
dead, this man stands here before you
whole in him.
11 He is ‘the stone which was regarded
as worthless by you, the builders, which
has become the head of the corner.’*
12 There is salvation in no one else, for
there is no other name under heaven that
is given among men, by which we must be
saved!”
13 Now when they saw the boldness of
Peter and John, and had perceived that
they were unlearned and ignorant men,
they marveled. They recognized that they
had been with Jesus.
14 Seeing the man who was healed
standing with them, they could say
nothing against it.
15 But when they had commanded them
to go aside out of the council, they
conferred among themselves,
16 saying, “What shall we do to these
men? Because indeed a notable miracle
has been done through them, as can be
plainly seen by all who dwell in
Jerusalem, and we can’t deny it.
17 But so that this spreads no further
among the people, let’s threaten them,
that from now on they don’t speak to
anyone in this name.”
18 They called them, and commanded
them not to speak at all nor teach in the
name of Jesus.

19 But Peter and John answered them,
“Whether it is right in the sight of God to
listen to you rather than to God, judge for
yourselves,
20 for we can’t help telling the things
which we saw and heard.”

21 When they had further threatened
them, they let them go, finding no way to
punish them, because of the people; for
everyone glorified God for that which was
done.
22 For the man on whom this miracle of
healing was performed was more than
forty years old.

23 Being let go, they came to their own
company and reported all that the chief
priests and the elders had said to them.
24 When they heard it, they lifted up
their voice to God with one accord and
said, “O Lord, you are God, who made the
sky, the earth, the sea, and all that is in
them;
25 who by the mouth of your servant
David, said,

‘Why do the nations rage,
and the peoples plot a vain thing?
26 The kings of the earth take a stand,
and the rulers plot together,
against the Lord, and against his
Christ.’†*
27 “For truly,‡ both Herod and Pontius
Pilate, with the Gentiles and the people of
Israel, were gathered together against
your holy servant Jesus, whom you
anointed,
28 to do whatever your hand and your
counsel foreordained to happen.
29 Now, Lord, look at their threats, and
grant to your servants to speak your word
with all boldness,
30 while you stretch out your hand to
heal; and that signs and wonders may be
done through the name of your holy
Servant Jesus.”

31 When they had prayed, the place was
shaken where they were gathered
together. They were all filled with the
Holy Spirit, and they spoke the word of
God with boldness.
32 The multitude of those who believed
were of one heart and soul. Not one of
them claimed that anything of the things
which he possessed was his own, but they
had all things in common.

* **4:11** Psalms 118:22 † **4:26** Christ (Greek) and Messiah (Hebrew) both mean Anointed One. * **4:26** Psalms 2:1-2
‡ **4:27** nu adds “in this city,”

33 With great power, the apostles gave
their testimony of the resurrection of the
Lord Jesus. Great grace was on them all.
34 For neither was there among them
any who lacked, for as many as were
owners of lands or houses sold them, and
brought the proceeds of the things that
were sold,
35 and laid them at the apostles' feet;
and distribution was made to each,
according as anyone had need.
36 Joses, who by the apostles was also
called Barnabas (which is, being
interpreted, Son of Encouragement), a
Levite, a man of Cyprus by race,
37 having a field, sold it and brought the
money and laid it at the apostles' feet.

5

1 But a certain man named Ananias,
with Sapphira his wife, sold a possession,
2 and kept back part of the price, his
wife also being aware of it, then brought a
certain part and laid it at the apostles' feet.
3 But Peter said, "Ananias, why has
Satan filled your heart to lie to the Holy
Spirit and to keep back part of the price of
the land?
4 While you kept it, didn't it remain your
own? After it was sold, wasn't it in your
power? How is it that you have conceived
this thing in your heart? You haven't lied
to men, but to God."
5 Ananias, hearing these words, fell
down and died. Great fear came on all
who heard these things.
6 The young men arose and wrapped
him up, and they carried him out and
buried him.
7 About three hours later, his wife, not
knowing what had happened, came in.
8 Peter answered her, "Tell me whether
you sold the land for so much."
She said, "Yes, for so much."
9 But Peter asked her, "How is it that you
have agreed together to tempt the Spirit of
the Lord? Behold, the feet of those who
have buried your husband are at the door,
and they will carry you out."
10 She fell down immediately at his feet
and died. The young men came in and
found her dead, and they carried her out
and buried her by her husband.
11 Great fear came on the whole
assembly, and on all who heard these
things.
12 By the hands of the apostles many
signs and wonders were done among the
people. They were all with one accord in
Solomon's porch.
13 None of the rest dared to join them;
however, the people honored them.
14 More believers were added to the
Lord, multitudes of both men and women.
15 They even carried out the sick into
the streets and laid them on cots and
mattresses, so that as Peter came by, at
least his shadow might overshadow some
of them.
16 The multitude also came together
from the cities around Jerusalem,
bringing sick people and those who were
tormented by unclean spirits; and they
were all healed.
17 But the high priest rose up, and all
those who were with him (which is the
sect of the Sadducees), and they were
filled with jealousy
18 and laid hands on the apostles, then
put them in public custody.
19 But an angel of the Lord opened the
prison doors by night, and brought them
out and said,
20 "Go stand and speak in the temple to
the people all the words of this life."
21 When they heard this, they entered
into the temple about daybreak and
taught. But the high priest and those who
were with him came and called the
council together, with all the senate of the
children of Israel, and sent to the prison to
have them brought.
22 But the officers who came didn't find
them in the prison. They returned and
reported,
23 "We found the prison shut and
locked, and the guards standing before
the doors, but when we opened them, we
found no one inside!"
24 Now when the high priest, the captain
of the temple, and the chief priests heard
these words, they were very perplexed

about them and what might become of this.
25 One came and told them, “Behold, the men whom you put in prison are in the temple, standing and teaching the people.”
26 Then the captain went with the officers, and brought them without violence, for they were afraid that the people might stone them.
27 When they had brought them, they set them before the council. The high priest questioned them,
28 saying, “Didn’t we strictly command you not to teach in this name? Behold, you have filled Jerusalem with your teaching, and intend to bring this man’s blood on us.”
29 But Peter and the apostles answered, “We must obey God rather than men.
30 The God of our fathers raised up Jesus, whom you killed, hanging him on a tree.
31 God exalted him with his right hand to be a Prince and a Savior, to give repentance to Israel, and remission of sins.
32 We are his witnesses of these things; and so also is the Holy Spirit, whom God has given to those who obey him.”
33 But they, when they heard this, were cut to the heart, and were determined to kill them.
34 But one stood up in the council, a Pharisee named Gamaliel, a teacher of the law, honored by all the people, and commanded to put the apostles out for a little while.
35 He said to them, “You men of Israel, be careful concerning these men, what you are about to do.
36 For before these days Theudas rose up, making himself out to be somebody; to whom a number of men, about four hundred, joined themselves. He was slain; and all, as many as obeyed him, were dispersed and came to nothing.
37 After this man, Judas of Galilee rose up in the days of the enrollment, and drew away some people after him. He also perished, and all, as many as obeyed him, were scattered abroad.
38 Now I tell you, withdraw from these men and leave them alone. For if this counsel or this work is of men, it will be overthrown.
39 But if it is of God, you will not be able to overthrow it, and you would be found even to be fighting against God!”
40 They agreed with him. Summoning the apostles, they beat them and commanded them not to speak in the name of Jesus, and let them go.
41 They therefore departed from the presence of the council, rejoicing that they were counted worthy to suffer dishonor for Jesus’ name.
42 Every day, in the temple and at home, they never stopped teaching and preaching Jesus, the Christ.

6

1 Now in those days, when the number of the disciples was multiplying, a complaint arose from the Hellenists† against the Hebrews, because their widows were neglected in the daily service.
2 The twelve summoned the multitude of the disciples and said, “It is not appropriate for us to forsake the word of God and serve tables.
3 Therefore, select from among you, brothers, seven men of good report, full of the Holy Spirit and of wisdom, whom we may appoint over this business.
4 But we will continue steadfastly in prayer and in the ministry of the word.”
5 These words pleased the whole multitude. They chose Stephen, a man full of faith and of the Holy Spirit, Philip, Prochorus, Nicanor, Timon, Parmenas, and Nicolaus, a proselyte of Antioch,
6 whom they set before the apostles. When they had prayed, they laid their hands on them.
7 The word of God increased and the number of the disciples greatly multiplied in Jerusalem. A great company of the priests were obedient to the faith.

† **6:1** The Hellenists used Greek language and culture, even though they were also of Hebrew descent.

8 Stephen, full of faith and power,
performed great wonders and signs
among the people.
9 But some of those who were of the
synagogue called “The Libertines”, and of
the Cyrenians, of the Alexandrians, and of
those of Cilicia and Asia arose, disputing
with Stephen.
10 They weren’t able to withstand the
wisdom and the Spirit by which he spoke.
11 Then they secretly induced men to
say, “We have heard him speak
blasphemous words against Moses and
God.”
12 They stirred up the people, the elders,
and the scribes, and came against him
and seized him, then brought him in to
the council,
13 and set up false witnesses who said,
“This man never stops speaking
blasphemous words against this holy
place and the law.
14 For we have heard him say that this
Jesus of Nazareth will destroy this place,
and will change the customs which Moses
delivered to us.”
15 All who sat in the council, fastening
their eyes on him, saw his face like it was
the face of an angel.

7

1 The high priest said, “Are these things
so?”
2 He said, “Brothers and fathers, listen.
The God of glory appeared to our father
Abraham when he was in Mesopotamia,
before he lived in Haran,
3 and said to him, ‘Get out of your land
and away from your relatives, and come
into a land which I will show you.’*
4 Then he came out of the land of the
Chaldaeans and lived in Haran. From
there, when his father was dead, God
moved him into this land where you are
now living.
5 He gave him no inheritance in it, no,
not so much as to set his foot on. He
promised that he would give it to him for
a possession, and to his offspring after
him, when he still had no child.
6 God spoke in this way: that his
offspring would live as aliens in a strange
land, and that they would be enslaved and
mistreated for four hundred years.
7 ‘I will judge the nation to which they
will be in bondage,’ said God, ‘and after
that they will come out and serve me in
this place.’*
8 He gave him the covenant of
circumcision. So Abraham became the
father of Isaac, and circumcised him the
eighth day. Isaac became the father of
Jacob, and Jacob became the father of the
twelve patriarchs.
9 “The patriarchs, moved with jealousy
against Joseph, sold him into Egypt. God
was with him
10 and delivered him out of all his
afflictions, and gave him favor and
wisdom before Pharaoh, king of Egypt. He
made him governor over Egypt and all his
house.
11 Now a famine came over all the land
of Egypt and Canaan, and great affliction.
Our fathers found no food.
12 But when Jacob heard that there was
grain in Egypt, he sent out our fathers the
first time.
13 On the second time Joseph was made
known to his brothers, and Joseph’s
family was revealed to Pharaoh.
14 Joseph sent and summoned Jacob his
father and all his relatives, seventy-five
souls.
15 Jacob went down into Egypt and he
died, himself and our fathers;
16 and they were brought back to
Shechem and laid in the tomb that
Abraham bought for a price in silver from
the children of Hamor of Shechem.
17 “But as the time of the promise came
close which God had sworn to Abraham,
the people grew and multiplied in Egypt,
18 until there arose a different king who
didn’t know Joseph.
19 The same took advantage of our race
and mistreated our fathers, and forced
them to abandon their babies, so that they
wouldn’t stay alive.
20 At that time Moses was born, and was
exceedingly handsome to God. He was

* **7:3** Genesis 12:1 * **7:7** Genesis 15:13-14

nourished three months in his father's house.
21 When he was abandoned, Pharaoh's daughter took him up and reared him as her own son.
22 Moses was instructed in all the wisdom of the Egyptians. He was mighty in his words and works.
23 But when he was forty years old, it came into his heart to visit his brothers,† the children of Israel.
24 Seeing one of them suffer wrong, he defended him and avenged him who was oppressed, striking the Egyptian.
25 He supposed that his brothers understood that God, by his hand, was giving them deliverance; but they didn't understand.
26 "The day following, he appeared to them as they fought, and urged them to be at peace again, saying, 'Sirs, you are brothers. Why do you wrong one another?'
27 But he who did his neighbor wrong pushed him away, saying, 'Who made you a ruler and a judge over us?
28 Do you want to kill me as you killed the Egyptian yesterday?'*
29 Moses fled at this saying, and became a stranger in the land of Midian, where he became the father of two sons.
30 "When forty years were fulfilled, an angel of the Lord appeared to him in the wilderness of Mount Sinai, in a flame of fire in a bush.
31 When Moses saw it, he wondered at the sight. As he came close to see, the voice of the Lord came to him,
32 'I am the God of your fathers: the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob.'* Moses trembled and dared not look.
33 The Lord said to him, 'Take off your sandals, for the place where you stand is holy ground.
34 I have surely seen the affliction of my people who are in Egypt, and have heard their groaning. I have come down to deliver them. Now come, I will send you into Egypt.'*
35 "This Moses whom they refused, saying, 'Who made you a ruler and a judge?'—God has sent him as both a ruler and a deliverer by the hand of the angel who appeared to him in the bush.
36 This man led them out, having worked wonders and signs in Egypt, in the Red Sea, and in the wilderness for forty years.
37 This is that Moses who said to the children of Israel, 'The Lord our God will raise up a prophet for you from among your brothers, like me.'‡*
38 This is he who was in the assembly in the wilderness with the angel that spoke to him on Mount Sinai, and with our fathers, who received living revelations to give to us,
39 to whom our fathers wouldn't be obedient, but rejected him and turned back in their hearts to Egypt,
40 saying to Aaron, 'Make us gods that will go before us, for as for this Moses who led us out of the land of Egypt, we don't know what has become of him.'*
41 They made a calf in those days, and brought a sacrifice to the idol, and rejoiced in the works of their hands.
42 But God turned away and gave them up to serve the army of the sky,§ as it is written in the book of the prophets,

'Did you offer to me slain animals and sacrifices
forty years in the wilderness, O house of Israel?
43 You took up the tabernacle of Moloch,
the star of your god Rephan,
the figures which you made to worship,
so I will carry you away* beyond Babylon.'

44 "Our fathers had the tabernacle of the testimony in the wilderness, even as he who spoke to Moses commanded him to

† **7:23** The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may be also correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **7:28** Exodus 2:14 * **7:32** Exodus 3:6 * **7:34** Exodus 3:5,7-8,10 ‡ **7:37** TR adds "You shall listen to him." * **7:37** Deuteronomy 18:15 * **7:40** Exodus 32:1 § **7:42** This idiom could also be translated "host of heaven", or "angelic beings", or "heavenly bodies." * **7:43** Amos 5:25-27

make it according to the pattern that he had seen;
45 which also our fathers, in their turn, brought in with Joshua when they entered into the possession of the nations whom God drove out before the face of our fathers to the days of David,
46 who found favor in the sight of God, and asked to find a habitation for the God of Jacob.
47 But Solomon built him a house.
48 However, the Most High doesn't dwell in temples made with hands, as the prophet says,
49 'heaven is my throne,
and the earth a footstool for my feet.
What kind of house will you build me?'
says the Lord.
'Or what is the place of my rest?
50 Didn't my hand make all these things?'*
51 "You stiff-necked and uncircumcised in heart and ears, you always resist the Holy Spirit! As your fathers did, so you do.
52 Which of the prophets didn't your fathers persecute? They killed those who foretold the coming of the Righteous One, of whom you have now become betrayers and murderers.
53 You received the law as it was ordained by angels, and didn't keep it!"
54 Now when they heard these things, they were cut to the heart, and they gnashed at him with their teeth.
55 But he, being full of the Holy Spirit, looked up steadfastly into heaven and saw the glory of God, and Jesus standing on the right hand of God,
56 and said, "Behold, I see the heavens opened and the Son of Man standing at the right hand of God!"
57 But they cried out with a loud voice and stopped their ears, then rushed at him with one accord.
58 They threw him out of the city and stoned him. The witnesses placed their garments at the feet of a young man named Saul.
59 They stoned Stephen as he called out, saying, "Lord Jesus, receive my spirit!"
60 He kneeled down and cried with a loud voice, "Lord, don't hold this sin against them!" When he had said this, he fell asleep.

8

1 Saul was consenting to his death. A great persecution arose against the assembly which was in Jerusalem in that day. They were all scattered abroad throughout the regions of Judea and Samaria, except for the apostles.
2 Devout men buried Stephen and lamented greatly over him.
3 But Saul ravaged the assembly, entering into every house and dragged both men and women off to prison.
4 Therefore those who were scattered abroad went around preaching the word.
5 Philip went down to the city of Samaria and proclaimed to them the Christ.
6 The multitudes listened with one accord to the things that were spoken by Philip when they heard and saw the signs which he did.
7 For unclean spirits came out of many of those who had them. They came out, crying with a loud voice. Many who had been paralyzed and lame were healed.
8 There was great joy in that city.
9 But there was a certain man, Simon by name, who used to practice sorcery in the city and amazed the people of Samaria, making himself out to be some great one,
10 to whom they all listened, from the least to the greatest, saying, "This man is that great power of God."
11 They listened to him because for a long time he had amazed them with his sorceries.
12 But when they believed Philip preaching good news concerning God's Kingdom and the name of Jesus Christ, they were baptized, both men and women.
13 Simon himself also believed. Being baptized, he continued with Philip. Seeing signs and great miracles occurring, he was amazed.
14 Now when the apostles who were at Jerusalem heard that Samaria had

* **7:50** Isaiah 66:1-2

received the word of God, they sent Peter and John to them,
15 who, when they had come down, prayed for them, that they might receive the Holy Spirit;
16 for as yet he had fallen on none of them. They had only been baptized in the name of Christ Jesus.
17 Then they laid their hands on them, and they received the Holy Spirit.
18 Now when Simon saw that the Holy Spirit was given through the laying on of the apostles' hands, he offered them money,
19 saying, "Give me also this power, that whomever I lay my hands on may receive the Holy Spirit."
20 But Peter said to him, "May your silver perish with you, because you thought you could obtain the gift of God with money!
21 You have neither part nor lot in this matter, for your heart isn't right before God.
22 Repent therefore of this, your wickedness, and ask God if perhaps the thought of your heart may be forgiven you.
23 For I see that you are in the poison of bitterness and in the bondage of iniquity."
24 Simon answered, "Pray for me to the Lord, that none of the things which you have spoken happen to me."
25 They therefore, when they had testified and spoken the word of the Lord, returned to Jerusalem, and preached the Good News to many villages of the Samaritans.
26 Then an angel of the Lord spoke to Philip, saying, "Arise, and go toward the south to the way that goes down from Jerusalem to Gaza. This is a desert."
27 He arose and went; and behold, there was a man of Ethiopia, a eunuch of great authority under Candace, queen of the Ethiopians, who was over all her treasure, who had come to Jerusalem to worship.
28 He was returning and sitting in his chariot, and was reading the prophet Isaiah.
29 The Spirit said to Philip, "Go near, and join yourself to this chariot."
30 Philip ran to him, and heard him reading Isaiah the prophet, and said, "Do you understand what you are reading?"
31 He said, "How can I, unless someone explains it to me?" He begged Philip to come up and sit with him.
32 Now the passage of the Scripture which he was reading was this,
"He was led as a sheep to the slaughter.
As a lamb before his shearer is silent,
so he doesn't open his mouth.
33 In his humiliation, his judgment was
taken away.
Who will declare His generation?
For his life is taken from the earth."*
34 The eunuch answered Philip, "Who is the prophet talking about? About himself, or about someone else?"
35 Philip opened his mouth, and beginning from this Scripture, preached to him about Jesus.
36 As they went on the way, they came to some water; and the eunuch said, "Behold, here is water. What is keeping me from being baptized?"
37 †
38 He commanded the chariot to stand still, and they both went down into the water, both Philip and the eunuch, and he baptized him.
39 When they came up out of the water, the Spirit of the Lord caught Philip away, and the eunuch didn't see him any more, for he went on his way rejoicing.
40 But Philip was found at Azotus. Passing through, he preached the Good News to all the cities until he came to Caesarea.

9

1 But Saul, still breathing threats and slaughter against the disciples of the Lord, went to the high priest
2 and asked for letters from him to the synagogues of Damascus, that if he found

* **8:33** Isaiah 53:7,8 † **8:37** TR adds *Philip said, "If you believe with all your heart, you may." He answered, "I believe that Jesus Christ is the Son of God."*

any who were of the Way, whether men or women, he might bring them bound to Jerusalem.
3 As he traveled, he got close to Damascus, and suddenly a light from the sky shone around him.
4 He fell on the earth, and heard a voice saying to him, "Saul, Saul, why do you persecute me?"
5 He said, "Who are you, Lord?"
The Lord said, "I am Jesus, whom you are persecuting.†
6 But‡ rise up and enter into the city, then you will be told what you must do."
7 The men who traveled with him stood speechless, hearing the sound, but seeing no one.
8 Saul arose from the ground, and when his eyes were opened, he saw no one. They led him by the hand and brought him into Damascus.
9 He was without sight for three days, and neither ate nor drank.
10 Now there was a certain disciple at Damascus named Ananias. The Lord said to him in a vision, "Ananias!"
He said, "Behold, it's me, Lord."
11 The Lord said to him, "Arise and go to the street which is called Straight, and inquire in the house of Judah§ for one named Saul, a man of Tarsus. For behold, he is praying,
12 and in a vision he has seen a man named Ananias coming in and laying his hands on him, that he might receive his sight."
13 But Ananias answered, "Lord, I have heard from many about this man, how much evil he did to your saints at Jerusalem.
14 Here he has authority from the chief priests to bind all who call on your name."
15 But the Lord said to him, "Go your way, for he is my chosen vessel to bear my name before the nations and kings, and the children of Israel.
16 For I will show him how many things he must suffer for my name's sake."
17 Ananias departed and entered into the house. Laying his hands on him, he said, "Brother Saul, the Lord, who appeared to you on the road by which you came, has sent me that you may receive your sight and be filled with the Holy Spirit."
18 Immediately something like scales fell from his eyes, and he received his sight. He arose and was baptized.
19 He took food and was strengthened.

Saul stayed several days with the disciples who were at Damascus.
20 Immediately in the synagogues he proclaimed the Christ, that he is the Son of God.
21 All who heard him were amazed, and said, "Isn't this he who in Jerusalem made havoc of those who called on this name? And he had come here intending to bring them bound before the chief priests!"

22 But Saul increased more in strength, and confounded the Jews who lived at Damascus, proving that this is the Christ.
23 When many days were fulfilled, the Jews conspired together to kill him,
24 but their plot became known to Saul. They watched the gates both day and night that they might kill him,
25 but his disciples took him by night and let him down through the wall, lowering him in a basket.

26 When Saul had come to Jerusalem, he tried to join himself to the disciples; but they were all afraid of him, not believing that he was a disciple.
27 But Barnabas took him and brought him to the apostles, and declared to them how he had seen the Lord on the way, and that he had spoken to him, and how at Damascus he had preached boldly in the name of Jesus.
28 He was with them entering into† Jerusalem,
29 preaching boldly in the name of the Lord Jesus.‡ He spoke and disputed

† **9:5** TR adds "It's hard for you to kick against the cattle prods." ‡ **9:6** TR omits "But" § **9:11** or, Judas † **9:28** TR and NU add "and going out" ‡ **9:29** TR and NU omit "Jesus" and reverse the order of verses 28 & 29. § **9:29** The Hellenists were Hebrews who used Greek language and culture.

against the Hellenists,§ but they were seeking to kill him.
30 When the brothers† knew it, they brought him down to Caesarea and sent him off to Tarsus.
31 So the assemblies throughout all Judea, Galilee, and Samaria had peace and were built up. They were multiplied, walking in the fear of the Lord and in the comfort of the Holy Spirit.
32 As Peter went throughout all those parts, he came down also to the saints who lived at Lydda.
33 There he found a certain man named Aeneas, who had been bedridden for eight years because he was paralyzed.
34 Peter said to him, "Aeneas, Jesus Christ heals you. Get up and make your bed!" Immediately he arose.
35 All who lived at Lydda and in Sharon saw him, and they turned to the Lord.
36 Now there was at Joppa a certain disciple named Tabitha, which when translated means Dorcas.‡ This woman was full of good works and acts of mercy which she did.
37 In those days, she became sick and died. When they had washed her, they laid her in an upper room.
38 As Lydda was near Joppa, the disciples, hearing that Peter was there, sent two men§ to him, imploring him not to delay in coming to them.
39 Peter got up and went with them. When he had come, they brought him into the upper room. All the widows stood by him weeping, and showing the tunics and other garments which Dorcas had made while she was with them.
40 Peter sent them all out, and knelt down and prayed. Turning to the body, he said, "Tabitha, get up!" She opened her eyes, and when she saw Peter, she sat up.
41 He gave her his hand and raised her up. Calling the saints and widows, he presented her alive.
42 This became known throughout all Joppa, and many believed in the Lord.
43 He stayed many days in Joppa with a tanner named Simon.

10

1 Now there was a certain man in Caesarea, Cornelius by name, a centurion of what was called the Italian Regiment,
2 a devout man, and one who feared God with all his house, who gave gifts for the needy generously to the people, and always prayed to God.
3 At about the ninth hour of the day,† he clearly saw in a vision an angel of God coming to him and saying to him, "Cornelius!"
4 He, fastening his eyes on him and being frightened, said, "What is it, Lord?"
He said to him, "Your prayers and your gifts to the needy have gone up for a memorial before God.
5 Now send men to Joppa, and get Simon, who is also called Peter.
6 He is staying with a tanner named Simon, whose house is by the seaside.‡
7 When the angel who spoke to him had departed, Cornelius called two of his household servants and a devout soldier of those who waited on him continually.
8 Having explained everything to them, he sent them to Joppa.
9 Now on the next day as they were on their journey and got close to the city, Peter went up on the housetop to pray at about noon.
10 He became hungry and desired to eat, but while they were preparing, he fell into a trance.
11 He saw heaven opened and a certain container descending to him, like a great sheet let down by four corners on the earth,
12 in which were all kinds of four-footed animals of the earth, wild animals, reptiles, and birds of the sky.
13 A voice came to him, "Rise, Peter, kill and eat!"
14 But Peter said, "Not so, Lord; for I have never eaten anything that is common or unclean."

† **9:30** The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." ‡ **9:36** "Dorcas" is Greek for "Gazelle." § **9:38** Reading from NU, TR; MT omits "two men"
† **10:3** 3:00 p.m. ‡ **10:6** TR adds "This one will tell you what it is necessary for you to do."

15 A voice came to him again the second time, "What God has cleansed, you must not call unclean."
16 This was done three times, and immediately the thing was received up into heaven.
17 Now while Peter was very perplexed in himself what the vision which he had seen might mean, behold, the men who were sent by Cornelius, having made inquiry for Simon's house, stood before the gate,
18 and called and asked whether Simon, who was also called Peter, was lodging there.
19 While Peter was pondering the vision, the Spirit said to him, "Behold, three§ men seek you.
20 But arise, get down, and go with them, doubting nothing; for I have sent them."
21 Peter went down to the men, and said, "Behold, I am he whom you seek. Why have you come?"
22 They said, "Cornelius, a centurion, a righteous man and one who fears God, and well spoken of by all the nation of the Jews, was directed by a holy angel to invite you to his house, and to listen to what you say."
23 So he called them in and provided a place to stay.

On the next day Peter arose and went out with them, and some of the brothers from Joppa accompanied him.
24 On the next day they entered into Caesarea. Cornelius was waiting for them, having called together his relatives and his near friends.
25 When Peter entered, Cornelius met him, fell down at his feet, and worshiped him.
26 But Peter raised him up, saying, "Stand up! I myself am also a man."
27 As he talked with him, he went in and found many gathered together.
28 He said to them, "You yourselves know how it is an unlawful thing for a man who is a Jew to join himself or come to one of another nation, but God has shown me that I shouldn't call any man unholy or unclean.
29 Therefore I also came without complaint when I was sent for. I ask therefore, why did you send for me?"

30 Cornelius said, "Four days ago, I was fasting until this hour; and at the ninth hour,† I prayed in my house, and behold, a man stood before me in bright clothing
31 and said, 'Cornelius, your prayer is heard, and your gifts to the needy are remembered in the sight of God.
32 Send therefore to Joppa and summon Simon, who is also called Peter. He is staying in the house of a tanner named Simon, by the seaside. When he comes, he will speak to you.'
33 Therefore I sent to you at once, and it was good of you to come. Now therefore we are all here present in the sight of God to hear all things that have been commanded you by God."

34 Peter opened his mouth and said, "Truly I perceive that God doesn't show favoritism;
35 but in every nation he who fears him and works righteousness is acceptable to him.
36 The word which he sent to the children of Israel, preaching good news of peace by Jesus Christ—he is Lord of all—
37 you yourselves know what happened, which was proclaimed throughout all Judea, beginning from Galilee, after the baptism which John preached;
38 how God anointed Jesus of Nazareth with the Holy Spirit and with power, who went about doing good and healing all who were oppressed by the devil, for God was with him.
39 We are witnesses of everything he did both in the country of the Jews and in Jerusalem; whom they also‡ killed, hanging him on a tree.
40 God raised him up the third day and gave him to be revealed,
41 not to all the people, but to witnesses who were chosen before by God, to us,

§ **10:19** Reading from TR and NU. MT omits "three" † **10:30** 3:00 p.m. ‡ **10:39** TR omits "also"

who ate and drank with him after he rose from the dead.
42 He commanded us to preach to the people and to testify that this is he who is appointed by God as the Judge of the living and the dead.
43 All the prophets testify about him, that through his name everyone who believes in him will receive remission of sins."
44 While Peter was still speaking these words, the Holy Spirit fell on all those who heard the word.
45 They of the circumcision who believed were amazed, as many as came with Peter, because the gift of the Holy Spirit was also poured out on the Gentiles.
46 For they heard them speaking in other languages and magnifying God.
Then Peter answered,
47 "Can anyone forbid these people from being baptized with water? They have received the Holy Spirit just like us."
48 He commanded them to be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ. Then they asked him to stay some days.

11

1 Now the apostles and the brothers† who were in Judea heard that the Gentiles had also received the word of God.
2 When Peter had come up to Jerusalem, those who were of the circumcision contended with him,
3 saying, "You went in to uncircumcised men and ate with them!"
4 But Peter began, and explained to them in order, saying,
5 "I was in the city of Joppa praying, and in a trance I saw a vision: a certain container descending, like it was a great sheet let down from heaven by four corners. It came as far as me.
6 When I had looked intently at it, I considered, and saw the four-footed animals of the earth, wild animals, creeping things, and birds of the sky.
7 I also heard a voice saying to me, 'Rise, Peter, kill and eat!'
8 But I said, 'Not so, Lord, for nothing unholy or unclean has ever entered into my mouth.'
9 But a voice answered me the second time out of heaven, 'What God has cleansed, don't you call unclean.'
10 This was done three times, and all were drawn up again into heaven.
11 Behold, immediately three men stood before the house where I was, having been sent from Caesarea to me.
12 The Spirit told me to go with them without discriminating. These six brothers also accompanied me, and we entered into the man's house.
13 He told us how he had seen the angel standing in his house and saying to him, 'Send to Joppa and get Simon, who is called Peter,
14 who will speak to you words by which you will be saved, you and all your house.'
15 As I began to speak, the Holy Spirit fell on them, even as on us at the beginning.
16 I remembered the word of the Lord, how he said, 'John indeed baptized in water, but you will be baptized in the Holy Spirit.'
17 If then God gave to them the same gift as us when we believed in the Lord Jesus Christ, who was I, that I could withstand God?"
18 When they heard these things, they held their peace and glorified God, saying, "Then God has also granted to the Gentiles repentance to life!"
19 They therefore who were scattered abroad by the oppression that arose about Stephen traveled as far as Phoenicia, Cyprus, and Antioch, speaking the word to no one except to Jews only.
20 But there were some of them, men of Cyprus and Cyrene, who, when they had come to Antioch, spoke to the Hellenists,‡ preaching the Lord Jesus.
21 The hand of the Lord was with them, and a great number believed and turned to the Lord.
22 The report concerning them came to the ears of the assembly which was in

† **11:1** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." ‡ **11:20** A Hellenist is someone who keeps Greek customs and culture.

Jerusalem. They sent out Barnabas to go as far as Antioch,
23 who, when he had come, and had seen the grace of God, was glad. He exhorted them all, that with purpose of heart they should remain near to the Lord.
24 For he was a good man, and full of the Holy Spirit and of faith, and many people were added to the Lord.
25 Barnabas went out to Tarsus to look for Saul.
26 When he had found him, he brought him to Antioch. For a whole year they were gathered together with the assembly, and taught many people. The disciples were first called Christians in Antioch.
27 Now in these days, prophets came down from Jerusalem to Antioch.
28 One of them named Agabus stood up and indicated by the Spirit that there should be a great famine all over the world, which also happened in the days of Claudius.
29 As any of the disciples had plenty, each determined to send relief to the brothers who lived in Judea;
30 which they also did, sending it to the elders by the hands of Barnabas and Saul.

12

1 Now about that time, King Herod stretched out his hands to oppress some of the assembly.
2 He killed James, the brother of John, with the sword.
3 When he saw that it pleased the Jews, he proceeded to seize Peter also. This was during the days of unleavened bread.
4 When he had arrested him, he put him in prison and delivered him to four squads of four soldiers each to guard him, intending to bring him out to the people after the Passover.
5 Peter therefore was kept in the prison, but constant prayer was made by the assembly to God for him.
6 The same night when Herod was about to bring him out, Peter was sleeping between two soldiers, bound with two chains. Guards in front of the door kept the prison.
7 And behold, an angel of the Lord stood by him, and a light shone in the cell. He struck Peter on the side and woke him up, saying, “Stand up quickly!” His chains fell off his hands.
8 The angel said to him, “Get dressed and put on your sandals.” He did so. He said to him, “Put on your cloak and follow me.”
9 And he went out and followed him. He didn’t know that what was being done by the angel was real, but thought he saw a vision.
10 When they were past the first and the second guard, they came to the iron gate that leads into the city, which opened to them by itself. They went out and went down one street, and immediately the angel departed from him.
11 When Peter had come to himself, he said, “Now I truly know that the Lord has sent out his angel and delivered me out of the hand of Herod, and from everything the Jewish people were expecting.”
12 Thinking about that, he came to the house of Mary, the mother of John who was called Mark, where many were gathered together and were praying.
13 When Peter knocked at the door of the gate, a servant girl named Rhoda came to answer.
14 When she recognized Peter’s voice, she didn’t open the gate for joy, but ran in and reported that Peter was standing in front of the gate.
15 They said to her, “You are crazy!” But she insisted that it was so. They said, “It is his angel.”
16 But Peter continued knocking. When they had opened, they saw him and were amazed.
17 But he, beckoning to them with his hand to be silent, declared to them how the Lord had brought him out of the prison. He said, “Tell these things to James and to the brothers.” Then he departed and went to another place.
18 Now as soon as it was day, there was no small stir among the soldiers about what had become of Peter.

19 When Herod had sought for him and
didn't find him, he examined the guards,
then commanded that they should be put
to death. He went down from Judea to
Caesarea, and stayed there.
20 Now Herod was very angry with the
people of Tyre and Sidon. They came with
one accord to him and, having made
Blastus, the king's personal aide, their
friend, they asked for peace, because their
country depended on the king's country
for food.
21 On an appointed day, Herod dressed
himself in royal clothing, sat on the
throne, and gave a speech to them.
22 The people shouted, "The voice of a
god, and not of a man!"
23 Immediately an angel of the Lord
struck him, because he didn't give God the
glory. Then he was eaten by worms and
died.
24 But the word of God grew and
multiplied.
25 Barnabas and Saul returned to†
Jerusalem when they had fulfilled their
service, also taking with them John who
was called Mark.

13

1 Now in the assembly that was at
Antioch there were some prophets and
teachers: Barnabas, Simeon who was
called Niger, Lucius of Cyrene, Manaen
the foster brother of Herod the tetrarch,
and Saul.
2 As they served the Lord and fasted, the
Holy Spirit said, "Separate Barnabas and
Saul for me, for the work to which I have
called them."
3 Then, when they had fasted and
prayed and laid their hands on them, they
sent them away.
4 So, being sent out by the Holy Spirit,
they went down to Seleucia. From there
they sailed to Cyprus.
5 When they were at Salamis, they
proclaimed God's word in the Jewish
synagogues. They also had John as their
attendant.
6 When they had gone through the
island to Paphos, they found a certain
sorcerer, a false prophet, a Jew whose
name was Bar Jesus,
7 who was with the proconsul, Sergius
Paulus, a man of understanding. This
man summoned Barnabas and Saul, and
sought to hear the word of God.
8 But Elymas the sorcerer (for so is his
name by interpretation) withstood them,
seeking to turn the proconsul away from
the faith.
9 But Saul, who is also called Paul, filled
with the Holy Spirit, fastened his eyes on
him
10 and said, "You son of the devil, full of
all deceit and all cunning, you enemy of
all righteousness, will you not cease to
pervert the right ways of the Lord?
11 Now, behold, the hand of the Lord is
on you, and you will be blind, not seeing
the sun for a season!"
Immediately a mist and darkness fell on
him. He went around seeking someone to
lead him by the hand.
12 Then the proconsul, when he saw
what was done, believed, being
astonished at the teaching of the Lord.
13 Now Paul and his company set sail
from Paphos and came to Perga in
Pamphylia. John departed from them and
returned to Jerusalem.
14 But they, passing on from Perga,
came to Antioch of Pisidia. They went into
the synagogue on the Sabbath day and sat
down.
15 After the reading of the law and the
prophets, the rulers of the synagogue sent
to them, saying, "Brothers, if you have any
word of exhortation for the people,
speak."
16 Paul stood up, and gesturing with his
hand said, "Men of Israel, and you who
fear God, listen.
17 The God of this people† chose our
fathers, and exalted the people when they
stayed as aliens in the land of Egypt, and
with an uplifted arm, he led them out of it.
18 For a period of about forty years he
put up with them in the wilderness.
19 When he had destroyed seven
nations in the land of Canaan, he gave

† **12:25** TR reads "from" instead of "to" † **13:17** TR, NU add "Israel"

them their land for an inheritance for
about four hundred fifty years.
20 After these things, he gave them
judges until Samuel the prophet.
21 Afterward they asked for a king, and
God gave to them Saul the son of Kish, a
man of the tribe of Benjamin, for forty
years.
22 When he had removed him, he raised
up David to be their king, to whom he also
testified, 'I have found David the son of
Jesse, a man after my heart, who will do
all my will.'
23 From this man's offspring, God has
brought salvation‡ to Israel according to
his promise,
24 before his coming, when John had
first preached the baptism of repentance
to Israel.§
25 As John was fulfilling his course, he
said, 'What do you suppose that I am? I
am not he. But behold, one comes after
me, the sandals of whose feet I am not
worthy to untie.'

26 "Brothers, children of the stock of
Abraham, and those among you who fear
God, the word of this salvation is sent out
to you.
27 For those who dwell in Jerusalem,
and their rulers, because they didn't know
him, nor the voices of the prophets which
are read every Sabbath, fulfilled them by
condemning him.
28 Though they found no cause for
death, they still asked Pilate to have him
killed.
29 When they had fulfilled all things that
were written about him, they took him
down from the tree and laid him in a
tomb.
30 But God raised him from the dead,
31 and he was seen for many days by
those who came up with him from Galilee
to Jerusalem, who are his witnesses to the
people.
32 We bring you good news of the
promise made to the fathers,
33 that God has fulfilled this to us, their
children, in that he raised up Jesus. As it is
also written in the second psalm,
'You are my Son.
Today I have become your father.'*
34 "Concerning that he raised him up
from the dead, now no more to return to
corruption, he has spoken thus: 'I will give
you the holy and sure blessings of David.'*
35 Therefore he says also in another
psalm, 'You will not allow your Holy One
to see decay.'*
36 For David, after he had in his own
generation served the counsel of God, fell
asleep, was laid with his fathers, and saw
decay.
37 But he whom God raised up saw no
decay.
38 Be it known to you therefore,
brothers,† that through this man is
proclaimed to you remission of sins;
39 and by him everyone who believes is
justified from all things, from which you
could not be justified by the law of Moses.
40 Beware therefore, lest that come on
you which is spoken in the prophets:
41 'Behold, you scoffers!
Wonder and perish,
for I work a work in your days,
a work which you will in no way
believe, if one declares it to you.' "*
42 So when the Jews went out of the
synagogue, the Gentiles begged that these
words might be preached to them the next
Sabbath.
43 Now when the synagogue broke up,
many of the Jews and of the devout
proselytes followed Paul and Barnabas;
who, speaking to them, urged them to
continue in the grace of God.
44 The next Sabbath, almost the whole
city was gathered together to hear the
word of God.
45 But when the Jews saw the
multitudes, they were filled with jealousy,
and contradicted the things which were
spoken by Paul, and blasphemed.

‡ **13:23** TR, NU read "a Savior, Jesus" instead of "salvation" § **13:24** TR, NU read "to all the people of Israel" instead of "to Israel" * **13:33** Psalms 2:7 * **13:34** Isaiah 55:3 * **13:35** Psalms 16:10 † **13:38** The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **13:41** Habakkuk 1:5

46 Paul and Barnabas spoke out boldly,
and said, “It was necessary that God’s
word should be spoken to you first. Since
indeed you thrust it from yourselves, and
judge yourselves unworthy of eternal life,
behold, we turn to the Gentiles.
47 For so has the Lord commanded us,
saying,
‘I have set you as a light for the Gentiles,
that you should bring salvation to the
uttermost parts of the earth.’ ”*
48 As the Gentiles heard this, they were
glad and glorified the word of God. As
many as were appointed to eternal life
believed.
49 The Lord’s word was spread abroad
throughout all the region.
50 But the Jews stirred up the devout
and prominent women and the chief men
of the city, and stirred up a persecution
against Paul and Barnabas, and threw
them out of their borders.
51 But they shook off the dust of their
feet against them, and came to Iconium.
52 The disciples were filled with joy and
with the Holy Spirit.

14

1 In Iconium, they entered together into
the synagogue of the Jews, and so spoke
that a great multitude both of Jews and of
Greeks believed.
2 But the disbelieving† Jews stirred up
and embittered the souls of the Gentiles
against the brothers.
3 Therefore they stayed there a long
time, speaking boldly in the Lord, who
testified to the word of his grace, granting
signs and wonders to be done by their
hands.
4 But the multitude of the city was
divided. Part sided with the Jews and part
with the apostles.
5 When some of both the Gentiles and
the Jews, with their rulers, made a violent
attempt to mistreat and stone them,
6 they became aware of it and fled to the
cities of Lycaonia, Lystra, Derbe, and the
surrounding region.
7 There they preached the Good News.
8 At Lystra a certain man sat, impotent
in his feet, a cripple from his mother’s
womb, who never had walked.
9 He was listening to Paul speaking,
who, fastening eyes on him and seeing
that he had faith to be made whole,
10 said with a loud voice, “Stand upright
on your feet!” He leaped up and walked.
11 When the multitude saw what Paul
had done, they lifted up their voice, saying
in the language of Lycaonia, “The gods
have come down to us in the likeness of
men!”
12 They called Barnabas “Jupiter”, and
Paul “Mercury”, because he was the chief
speaker.
13 The priest of Jupiter, whose temple
was in front of their city, brought oxen
and garlands to the gates, and would have
made a sacrifice along with the
multitudes.
14 But when the apostles, Barnabas and
Paul, heard of it, they tore their clothes
and sprang into the multitude, crying out,
15 “Men, why are you doing these
things? We also are men of the same
nature as you, and bring you good news,
that you should turn from these vain
things to the living God, who made the
sky, the earth, the sea, and all that is in
them;
16 who in the generations gone by
allowed all the nations to walk in their
own ways.
17 Yet he didn’t leave himself without
witness, in that he did good and gave you‡
rains from the sky and fruitful seasons,
filling our hearts with food and gladness.”
18 Even saying these things, they hardly
stopped the multitudes from making a
sacrifice to them.
19 But some Jews from Antioch and
Iconium came there, and having
persuaded the multitudes, they stoned
Paul and dragged him out of the city,
supposing that he was dead.
20 But as the disciples stood around him,
he rose up, and entered into the city. On
the next day he went out with Barnabas to
Derbe.

* **13:47** Isaiah 49:6 † **14:2** or, disobedient ‡ **14:17** TR reads “us” instead of “you”

21 When they had preached the Good
News to that city and had made many
disciples, they returned to Lystra,
Iconium, and Antioch,
22 strengthening the souls of the
disciples, exhorting them to continue in
the faith, and that through many
afflictions we must enter into God's
Kingdom.
23 When they had appointed elders for
them in every assembly, and had prayed
with fasting, they commended them to the
Lord on whom they had believed.
24 They passed through Pisidia and
came to Pamphylia.
25 When they had spoken the word in
Perga, they went down to Attalia.
26 From there they sailed to Antioch,
from where they had been committed to
the grace of God for the work which they
had fulfilled.
27 When they had arrived and had
gathered the assembly together, they
reported all the things that God had done
with them, and that he had opened a door
of faith to the nations.
28 They stayed there with the disciples
for a long time.

15

1 Some men came down from Judea and
taught the brothers,† "Unless you are
circumcised after the custom of Moses,
you can't be saved."
2 Therefore when Paul and Barnabas
had no small discord and discussion with
them, they appointed Paul, Barnabas, and
some others of them to go up to Jerusalem
to the apostles and elders about this
question.
3 They, being sent on their way by the
assembly, passed through both Phoenicia
and Samaria, declaring the conversion of
the Gentiles. They caused great joy to all
the brothers.
4 When they had come to Jerusalem,
they were received by the assembly and
the apostles and the elders, and they
reported everything that God had done
with them.
5 But some of the sect of the Pharisees
who believed rose up, saying, "It is
necessary to circumcise them, and to
command them to keep the law of Moses."
6 The apostles and the elders were
gathered together to see about this matter.
7 When there had been much
discussion, Peter rose up and said to them,
"Brothers, you know that a good while ago
God made a choice among you that by my
mouth the nations should hear the word
of the Good News and believe.
8 God, who knows the heart, testified
about them, giving them the Holy Spirit,
just like he did to us.
9 He made no distinction between us
and them, cleansing their hearts by faith.
10 Now therefore why do you tempt
God, that you should put a yoke on the
neck of the disciples which neither our
fathers nor we were able to bear?
11 But we believe that we are saved
through the grace of the Lord Jesus,‡ just
as they are."
12 All the multitude kept silence, and
they listened to Barnabas and Paul
reporting what signs and wonders God
had done among the nations through
them.
13 After they were silent, James
answered, "Brothers, listen to me.
14 Simeon has reported how God first
visited the nations to take out of them a
people for his name.
15 This agrees with the words of the
prophets. As it is written,
16 'After these things I will return.
I will again build the tabernacle of David,
which has fallen.
I will again build its ruins.
I will set it up
17 that the rest of men may seek after the
Lord:
all the Gentiles who are called by my
name,
says the Lord, who does all these things.'*
18 "All of God's works are known to him
from eternity.

† **15:1** The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." ‡ **15:11** TR adds "Christ" * **15:17** Amos 9:11-12

19 Therefore my judgment is that we
don't trouble those from among the
Gentiles who turn to God,
20 but that we write to them that they
abstain from the pollution of idols, from
sexual immorality, from what is
strangled, and from blood.
21 For Moses from generations of old has
in every city those who preach him, being
read in the synagogues every Sabbath."
22 Then it seemed good to the apostles
and the elders, with the whole assembly,
to choose men out of their company, and
send them to Antioch with Paul and
Barnabas: Judas called Barsabbas, and
Silas, chief men among the brothers.§
23 They wrote these things by their
hand:
"The apostles, the elders, and the
brothers, to the brothers who are of the
Gentiles in Antioch, Syria, and Cilicia:
greetings.
24 Because we have heard that some
who went out from us have troubled you
with words, unsettling your souls, saying,
'You must be circumcised and keep the
law,' to whom we gave no commandment;
25 it seemed good to us, having come to
one accord, to choose out men and send
them to you with our beloved Barnabas
and Paul,
26 men who have risked their lives for
the name of our Lord Jesus Christ.
27 We have sent therefore Judas and
Silas, who themselves will also tell you the
same things by word of mouth.
28 For it seemed good to the Holy Spirit,
and to us, to lay no greater burden on you
than these necessary things:
29 that you abstain from things
sacrificed to idols, from blood, from things
strangled, and from sexual immorality,
from which if you keep yourselves, it will
be well with you. Farewell."
30 So, when they were sent off, they
came to Antioch. Having gathered the
multitude together, they delivered the
letter.
31 When they had read it, they rejoiced
over the encouragement.
32 Judas and Silas, also being prophets
themselves, encouraged the brothers with
many words and strengthened them.
33 After they had spent some time there,
they were dismissed in peace from the
brothers to the apostles.
34 †
35 But Paul and Barnabas stayed in
Antioch, teaching and preaching the word
of the Lord, with many others also.
36 After some days Paul said to
Barnabas, "Let's return now and visit our
brothers in every city in which we
proclaimed the word of the Lord, to see
how they are doing."
37 Barnabas planned to take John, who
was called Mark, with them also.
38 But Paul didn't think that it was a
good idea to take with them someone who
had withdrawn from them in Pamphylia,
and didn't go with them to do the work.
39 Then the contention grew so sharp
that they separated from each other.
Barnabas took Mark with him and sailed
away to Cyprus,
40 but Paul chose Silas and went out,
being commended by the brothers to the
grace of God.
41 He went through Syria and Cilicia,
strengthening the assemblies.

16

1 He came to Derbe and Lystra; and
behold, a certain disciple was there,
named Timothy, the son of a Jewess who
believed, but his father was a Greek.
2 The brothers who were at Lystra and
Iconium gave a good testimony about him.
3 Paul wanted to have him go out with
him, and he took and circumcised him
because of the Jews who were in those
parts, for they all knew that his father was
a Greek.
4 As they went on their way through the
cities, they delivered the decrees to them
to keep which had been ordained by the

§ **15:22** The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." † **15:34** Some manuscripts add: *But it seemed good to Silas to stay there.*

apostles and elders who were at Jerusalem.
5 So the assemblies were strengthened in the faith, and increased in number daily.
6 When they had gone through the region of Phrygia and Galatia, they were forbidden by the Holy Spirit to speak the word in Asia.
7 When they had come opposite Mysia, they tried to go into Bithynia, but the Spirit didn't allow them.
8 Passing by Mysia, they came down to Troas.
9 A vision appeared to Paul in the night. There was a man of Macedonia standing, begging him and saying, "Come over into Macedonia and help us."
10 When he had seen the vision, immediately we sought to go out to Macedonia, concluding that the Lord had called us to preach the Good News to them.
11 Setting sail therefore from Troas, we made a straight course to Samothrace, and the day following to Neapolis;
12 and from there to Philippi, which is a city of Macedonia, the foremost of the district, a Roman colony. We were staying some days in this city.
13 On the Sabbath day we went outside of the city by a riverside, where we supposed there was a place of prayer, and we sat down and spoke to the women who had come together.
14 A certain woman named Lydia, a seller of purple, of the city of Thyatira, one who worshiped God, heard us. The Lord opened her heart to listen to the things which were spoken by Paul.
15 When she and her household were baptized, she begged us, saying, "If you have judged me to be faithful to the Lord, come into my house and stay." So she persuaded us.
16 As we were going to prayer, a certain girl having a spirit of divination met us, who brought her masters much gain by fortune telling.
17 Following Paul and us, she cried out, "These men are servants of the Most High God, who proclaim to us a way of salvation!"
18 She was doing this for many days.

But Paul, becoming greatly annoyed, turned and said to the spirit, "I command you in the name of Jesus Christ to come out of her!" It came out that very hour.
19 But when her masters saw that the hope of their gain was gone, they seized Paul and Silas and dragged them into the marketplace before the rulers.
20 When they had brought them to the magistrates, they said, "These men, being Jews, are agitating our city
21 and advocate customs which it is not lawful for us to accept or to observe, being Romans."
22 The multitude rose up together against them and the magistrates tore their clothes from them, then commanded them to be beaten with rods.
23 When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely.
24 Having received such a command, he threw them into the inner prison and secured their feet in the stocks.
25 But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.
26 Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone's bonds were loosened.
27 The jailer, being roused out of sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped.
28 But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, "Don't harm yourself, for we are all here!"
29 He called for lights, sprang in, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas,
30 brought them out, and said, "Sirs, what must I do to be saved?"
31 They said, "Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household."
32 They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house.

33 He took them the same hour of the night and washed their stripes, and was immediately baptized, he and all his household.
34 He brought them up into his house and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly with all his household, having believed in God.
35 But when it was day, the magistrates sent the sergeants, saying, "Let those men go."
36 The jailer reported these words to Paul, saying, "The magistrates have sent to let you go; now therefore come out and go in peace."
37 But Paul said to them, "They have beaten us publicly without a trial, men who are Romans, and have cast us into prison! Do they now release us secretly? No, most certainly, but let them come themselves and bring us out!"
38 The sergeants reported these words to the magistrates, and they were afraid when they heard that they were Romans,
39 and they came and begged them. When they had brought them out, they asked them to depart from the city.
40 They went out of the prison and entered into Lydia's house. When they had seen the brothers, they encouraged them, then departed.

17

1 Now when they had passed through Amphipolis and Apollonia, they came to Thessalonica, where there was a Jewish synagogue.
2 Paul, as was his custom, went in to them; and for three Sabbath days reasoned with them from the Scriptures,
3 explaining and demonstrating that the Christ had to suffer and rise again from the dead, and saying, "This Jesus, whom I proclaim to you, is the Christ."
4 Some of them were persuaded and joined Paul and Silas: of the devout Greeks a great multitude, and not a few of the chief women.
5 But the unpersuaded Jews took along† some wicked men from the marketplace and gathering a crowd, set the city in an uproar. Assaulting the house of Jason, they sought to bring them out to the people.
6 When they didn't find them, they dragged Jason and certain brothers‡ before the rulers of the city, crying, "These who have turned the world upside down have come here also,
7 whom Jason has received. These all act contrary to the decrees of Caesar, saying that there is another king, Jesus!"
8 The multitude and the rulers of the city were troubled when they heard these things.
9 When they had taken security from Jason and the rest, they let them go.

10 The brothers immediately sent Paul and Silas away by night to Beroea. When they arrived, they went into the Jewish synagogue.

11 Now these were more noble than those in Thessalonica, in that they received the word with all readiness of mind, examining the Scriptures daily to see whether these things were so.
12 Many of them therefore believed; also of the prominent Greek women, and not a few men.
13 But when the Jews of Thessalonica had knowledge that the word of God was proclaimed by Paul at Beroea also, they came there likewise, agitating the multitudes.
14 Then the brothers immediately sent out Paul to go as far as to the sea, and Silas and Timothy still stayed there.
15 But those who escorted Paul brought him as far as Athens. Receiving a commandment to Silas and Timothy that they should come to him very quickly, they departed.

16 Now while Paul waited for them at Athens, his spirit was provoked within him as he saw the city full of idols.

† **17:5** TR reads "And the Jews who were unpersuaded, becoming envious and taking along" instead of "But the unpersuaded Jews took along" ‡ **17:6** The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may be also correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

17 So he reasoned in the synagogue with
the Jews and the devout persons, and in
the marketplace every day with those
who met him.
18 Some of the Epicurean and Stoic
philosophers also§ were conversing with
him. Some said, “What does this babbler
want to say?”
Others said, “He seems to be advocating
foreign deities,” because he preached
Jesus and the resurrection.
19 They took hold of him and brought
him to the Areopagus, saying, “May we
know what this new teaching is, which
you are speaking about?
20 For you bring certain strange things
to our ears. We want to know therefore
what these things mean.”
21 Now all the Athenians and the
strangers living there spent their time in
nothing else, but either to tell or to hear
some new thing.
22 Paul stood in the middle of the
Areopagus and said, “You men of Athens, I
perceive that you are very religious in all
things.
23 For as I passed along and observed
the objects of your worship, I also found
an altar with this inscription: ‘TO AN
UNKNOWN GOD.’ What therefore you
worship in ignorance, I announce to you.
24 The God who made the world and all
things in it, he, being Lord of heaven and
earth, doesn’t dwell in temples made with
hands.
25 He isn’t served by men’s hands, as
though he needed anything, seeing he
himself gives to all life and breath and all
things.
26 He made from one blood every nation
of men to dwell on all the surface of the
earth, having determined appointed
seasons and the boundaries of their
dwellings,
27 that they should seek the Lord, if
perhaps they might reach out for him and
find him, though he is not far from each
one of us.
28 ‘For in him we live, move, and have
our being.’ As some of your own poets
have said, ‘For we are also his offspring.’
29 Being then the offspring of God, we
ought not to think that the Divine Nature
is like gold, or silver, or stone, engraved
by art and design of man.
30 The times of ignorance therefore God
overlooked. But now he commands that
all people everywhere should repent,
31 because he has appointed a day in
which he will judge the world in
righteousness by the man whom he has
ordained; of which he has given
assurance to all men, in that he has raised
him from the dead.”
32 Now when they heard of the
resurrection of the dead, some mocked;
but others said, “We want to hear you
again concerning this.”
33 Thus Paul went out from among
them.
34 But certain men joined with him and
believed, including Dionysius the
Areopagite, and a woman named
Damaris, and others with them.

18

1 After these things Paul departed from
Athens and came to Corinth.
2 He found a certain Jew named Aquila,
a man of Pontus by race, who had recently
come from Italy with his wife Priscilla,
because Claudius had commanded all the
Jews to depart from Rome. He came to
them,
3 and because he practiced the same
trade, he lived with them and worked, for
by trade they were tent makers.
4 He reasoned in the synagogue every
Sabbath and persuaded Jews and Greeks.
5 When Silas and Timothy came down
from Macedonia, Paul was compelled by
the Spirit, testifying to the Jews that Jesus
was the Christ.
6 When they opposed him and
blasphemed, he shook out his clothing
and said to them, “Your blood be on your
own heads! I am clean. From now on, I
will go to the Gentiles!”
7 He departed there and went into the
house of a certain man named Justus, one
who worshiped God, whose house was
next door to the synagogue.

§ **17:18** TR omits “also”

8 Crispus, the ruler of the synagogue, believed in the Lord with all his house. Many of the Corinthians, when they heard, believed and were baptized.
9 The Lord said to Paul in the night by a vision, "Don't be afraid, but speak and don't be silent;
10 for I am with you, and no one will attack you to harm you, for I have many people in this city."
11 He lived there a year and six months, teaching the word of God among them.
12 But when Gallio was proconsul of Achaia, the Jews with one accord rose up against Paul and brought him before the judgment seat,
13 saying, "This man persuades men to worship God contrary to the law."
14 But when Paul was about to open his mouth, Gallio said to the Jews, "If indeed it were a matter of wrong or of wicked crime, you Jews, it would be reasonable that I should bear with you;
15 but if they are questions about words and names and your own law, look to it yourselves. For I don't want to be a judge of these matters."
16 So he drove them from the judgment seat.
17 Then all the Greeks seized Sosthenes, the ruler of the synagogue, and beat him before the judgment seat. Gallio didn't care about any of these things.
18 Paul, having stayed after this many more days, took his leave of the brothers,† and sailed from there for Syria, together with Priscilla and Aquila. He shaved his head in Cenchreae, for he had a vow.
19 He came to Ephesus, and he left them there; but he himself entered into the synagogue and reasoned with the Jews.
20 When they asked him to stay with them a longer time, he declined;
21 but taking his leave of them, he said, "I must by all means keep this coming feast in Jerusalem, but I will return again to you if God wills." Then he set sail from Ephesus.
22 When he had landed at Caesarea, he went up and greeted the assembly, and went down to Antioch.
23 Having spent some time there, he departed and went through the region of Galatia and Phrygia, in order, establishing all the disciples.
24 Now a certain Jew named Apollos, an Alexandrian by race, an eloquent man, came to Ephesus. He was mighty in the Scriptures.
25 This man had been instructed in the way of the Lord; and being fervent in spirit, he spoke and taught accurately the things concerning Jesus, although he knew only the baptism of John.
26 He began to speak boldly in the synagogue. But when Priscilla and Aquila heard him, they took him aside, and explained to him the way of God more accurately.
27 When he had determined to pass over into Achaia, the brothers encouraged him; and wrote to the disciples to receive him. When he had come, he greatly helped those who had believed through grace;
28 for he powerfully refuted the Jews, publicly showing by the Scriptures that Jesus was the Christ.

19

1 While Apollos was at Corinth, Paul, having passed through the upper country, came to Ephesus and found certain disciples.
2 He said to them, "Did you receive the Holy Spirit when you believed?"
They said to him, "No, we haven't even heard that there is a Holy Spirit."
3 He said, "Into what then were you baptized?"
They said, "Into John's baptism."
4 Paul said, "John indeed baptized with the baptism of repentance, saying to the people that they should believe in the one who would come after him, that is, in Christ Jesus."†
5 When they heard this, they were baptized in the name of the Lord Jesus.

† **18:18** The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." † **19:4** NU omits Christ.

6 When Paul had laid his hands on
them, the Holy Spirit came on them and
they spoke with other languages and
prophesied.
7 They were about twelve men in all.

8 He entered into the synagogue and
spoke boldly for a period of three months,
reasoning and persuading about the
things concerning God's Kingdom.

9 But when some were hardened and
disobedient, speaking evil of the Way
before the multitude, he departed from
them and separated the disciples,
reasoning daily in the school of Tyrannus.
10 This continued for two years, so that
all those who lived in Asia heard the word
of the Lord Jesus, both Jews and Greeks.

11 God worked special miracles by the
hands of Paul,
12 so that even handkerchiefs or aprons
were carried away from his body to the
sick, and the diseases departed from
them, and the evil spirits went out.
13 But some of the itinerant Jews,
exorcists, took on themselves to invoke
over those who had the evil spirits the
name of the Lord Jesus, saying, "We
adjure you by Jesus whom Paul preaches."
14 There were seven sons of one Sceva, a
Jewish chief priest, who did this.

15 The evil spirit answered, "Jesus I
know, and Paul I know, but who are you?"
16 The man in whom the evil spirit was
leaped on them, overpowered them, and
prevailed against them, so that they fled
out of that house naked and wounded.
17 This became known to all, both Jews
and Greeks, who lived at Ephesus. Fear
fell on them all, and the name of the Lord
Jesus was magnified.
18 Many also of those who had believed
came, confessing and declaring their
deeds.
19 Many of those who practiced magical
arts brought their books together and
burned them in the sight of all. They
counted their price, and found it to be
fifty thousand pieces of silver.‡

20 So the word of the Lord was growing
and becoming mighty.

21 Now after these things had ended,
Paul determined in the Spirit, when he
had passed through Macedonia and
Achaia, to go to Jerusalem, saying, "After I
have been there, I must also see Rome."
22 Having sent into Macedonia two of
those who served him, Timothy and
Erastus, he himself stayed in Asia for a
while.
23 About that time there arose no small
disturbance concerning the Way.
24 For a certain man named Demetrius,
a silversmith who made silver shrines of
Artemis, brought no little business to the
craftsmen,
25 whom he gathered together with the
workmen of like occupation, and said,
"Sirs, you know that by this business we
have our wealth.
26 You see and hear that not at Ephesus
alone, but almost throughout all Asia, this
Paul has persuaded and turned away
many people, saying that they are no gods
that are made with hands.
27 Not only is there danger that this our
trade come into disrepute, but also that
the temple of the great goddess Artemis
will be counted as nothing and her
majesty destroyed, whom all Asia and the
world worships."

28 When they heard this they were filled
with anger, and cried out, saying, "Great is
Artemis of the Ephesians!"
29 The whole city was filled with
confusion, and they rushed with one
accord into the theater, having seized
Gaius and Aristarchus, men of
Macedonia, Paul's companions in travel.
30 When Paul wanted to enter in to the
people, the disciples didn't allow him.
31 Certain also of the Asiarchs, being his
friends, sent to him and begged him not to
venture into the theater.
32 Some therefore cried one thing, and
some another, for the assembly was in
confusion. Most of them didn't know why
they had come together.

‡ **19:19** The 50,000 pieces of silver here probably referred to 50,000 drachmas. If so, the value of the burned books was equivalent to about 160 man-years of wages for agricultural laborers

33 They brought Alexander out of the
multitude, the Jews putting him forward.
Alexander beckoned with his hand, and
would have made a defense to the people.
34 But when they perceived that he was
a Jew, all with one voice for a time of
about two hours cried out, “Great is
Artemis of the Ephesians!”
35 When the town clerk had quieted the
multitude, he said, “You men of Ephesus,
what man is there who doesn’t know that
the city of the Ephesians is temple keeper
of the great goddess Artemis, and of the
image which fell down from Zeus?
36 Seeing then that these things can’t be
denied, you ought to be quiet and to do
nothing rash.
37 For you have brought these men here,
who are neither robbers of temples nor
blasphemers of your goddess.
38 If therefore Demetrius and the
craftsmen who are with him have a
matter against anyone, the courts are
open and there are proconsuls. Let them
press charges against one another.
39 But if you seek anything about other
matters, it will be settled in the regular
assembly.
40 For indeed we are in danger of being
accused concerning today’s riot, there
being no cause. Concerning it, we
wouldn’t be able to give an account of this
commotion.”
41 When he had thus spoken, he
dismissed the assembly.

20

1 After the uproar had ceased, Paul sent
for the disciples, took leave of them, and
departed to go into Macedonia.
2 When he had gone through those parts
and had encouraged them with many
words, he came into Greece.
3 When he had spent three months
there, and a plot was made against him by
Jews as he was about to set sail for Syria,
he determined to return through
Macedonia.
4 These accompanied him as far as Asia:
Sopater of Beroea, Aristarchus and
Secundus of the Thessalonians, Gaius of
Derbe, Timothy, and Tychicus and
Trophimus of Asia.
5 But these had gone ahead, and were
waiting for us at Troas.
6 We sailed away from Philippi after the
days of Unleavened Bread, and came to
them at Troas in five days, where we
stayed seven days.
7 On the first day of the week, when the
disciples were gathered together to break
bread, Paul talked with them, intending to
depart on the next day; and continued his
speech until midnight.
8 There were many lights in the upper
room where we† were gathered together.
9 A certain young man named Eutychus
sat in the window, weighed down with
deep sleep. As Paul spoke still longer,
being weighed down by his sleep, he fell
down from the third floor and was taken
up dead.
10 Paul went down and fell upon him,
and embracing him said, “Don’t be
troubled, for his life is in him.”
11 When he had gone up, had broken
bread and eaten, and had talked with
them a long while, even until break of
day, he departed.
12 They brought the boy in alive, and
were greatly comforted.
13 But we, going ahead to the ship, set
sail for Assos, intending to take Paul
aboard there; for he had so arranged,
intending himself to go by land.
14 When he met us at Assos, we took him
aboard and came to Mitylene.
15 Sailing from there, we came the
following day opposite Chios. The next
day we touched at Samos and stayed at
Trogyllium, and the day after we came to
Miletus.
16 For Paul had determined to sail past
Ephesus, that he might not have to spend
time in Asia; for he was hastening, if it
were possible for him, to be in Jerusalem
on the day of Pentecost.
17 From Miletus he sent to Ephesus and
called to himself the elders of the
assembly.

† **20:8** TR reads “they” instead of “we”

18 When they had come to him, he said
to them, "You yourselves know, from the
first day that I set foot in Asia, how I was
with you all the time,
19 serving the Lord with all humility,
with many tears, and with trials which
happened to me by the plots of the Jews;
20 how I didn't shrink from declaring to
you anything that was profitable, teaching
you publicly and from house to house,
21 testifying both to Jews and to Greeks
repentance toward God and faith toward
our Lord Jesus.‡
22 Now, behold, I go bound by the Spirit
to Jerusalem, not knowing what will
happen to me there;
23 except that the Holy Spirit testifies in
every city, saying that bonds and
afflictions wait for me.
24 But these things don't count; nor do I
hold my life dear to myself, so that I may
finish my race with joy, and the ministry
which I received from the Lord Jesus, to
fully testify to the Good News of the grace
of God.
25 "Now, behold, I know that you all,
among whom I went about preaching
God's Kingdom, will see my face no more.
26 Therefore I testify to you today that I
am clean from the blood of all men,
27 for I didn't shrink from declaring to
you the whole counsel of God.
28 Take heed, therefore, to yourselves
and to all the flock, in which the Holy
Spirit has made you overseers, to
shepherd the assembly of the Lord and§
God which he purchased with his own
blood.
29 For I know that after my departure,
vicious wolves will enter in among you,
not sparing the flock.
30 Men will arise from among your own
selves, speaking perverse things, to draw
away the disciples after them.
31 Therefore watch, remembering that
for a period of three years I didn't cease to
admonish everyone night and day with
tears.
32 Now, brothers,† I entrust you to God
and to the word of his grace, which is able
to build up and to give you the inheritance
among all those who are sanctified.
33 I coveted no one's silver, gold, or
clothing.
34 You yourselves know that these
hands served my necessities, and those
who were with me.
35 In all things I gave you an example,
that so laboring you ought to help the
weak, and to remember the words of the
Lord Jesus, that he himself said, 'It is more
blessed to give than to receive.' "
36 When he had spoken these things, he
knelt down and prayed with them all.
37 They all wept freely, and fell on Paul's
neck and kissed him,
38 sorrowing most of all because of the
word which he had spoken, that they
should see his face no more. Then they
accompanied him to the ship.

21

1 When we had departed from them and
had set sail, we came with a straight
course to Cos, and the next day to Rhodes,
and from there to Patara.
2 Having found a ship crossing over to
Phoenicia, we went aboard and set sail.
3 When we had come in sight of Cyprus,
leaving it on the left hand, we sailed to
Syria and landed at Tyre, for the ship was
there to unload her cargo.
4 Having found disciples, we stayed
there seven days. These said to Paul
through the Spirit that he should not go
up to Jerusalem.
5 When those days were over, we
departed and went on our journey. They
all, with wives and children, brought us
on our way until we were out of the city.
Kneeling down on the beach, we prayed.
6 After saying goodbye to each other, we
went on board the ship, and they
returned home again.
7 When we had finished the voyage
from Tyre, we arrived at Ptolemais. We

‡ **20:21** TR adds "Christ" § **20:28** TR, NU omit "the Lord and" † **20:32** The word for "brothers" here and where the context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

greeted the brothers and stayed with
them one day.
8 On the next day, we who were Paul's
companions departed and came to
Caesarea.
We entered into the house of Philip the
evangelist, who was one of the seven, and
stayed with him.
9 Now this man had four virgin
daughters who prophesied.
10 As we stayed there some days, a
certain prophet named Agabus came
down from Judea.
11 Coming to us and taking Paul's belt,
he bound his own feet and hands, and
said, "The Holy Spirit says: 'So the Jews at
Jerusalem will bind the man who owns
this belt, and will deliver him into the
hands of the Gentiles.' "
12 When we heard these things, both we
and the people of that place begged him
not to go up to Jerusalem.
13 Then Paul answered, "What are you
doing, weeping and breaking my heart?
For I am ready not only to be bound, but
also to die at Jerusalem for the name of
the Lord Jesus."
14 When he would not be persuaded, we
ceased, saying, "The Lord's will be done."
15 After these days we took up our
baggage and went up to Jerusalem.
16 Some of the disciples from Caesarea
also went with us, bringing one Mnason
of Cyprus, an early disciple, with whom
we would stay.
17 When we had come to Jerusalem, the
brothers received us gladly.
18 The day following, Paul went in with
us to James; and all the elders were
present.
19 When he had greeted them, he
reported one by one the things which God
had worked among the Gentiles through
his ministry.
20 They, when they heard it, glorified
God. They said to him, "You see, brother,
how many thousands there are among the
Jews of those who have believed, and they
are all zealous for the law.
21 They have been informed about you,
that you teach all the Jews who are among
the Gentiles to forsake Moses, telling them
not to circumcise their children and not to
walk after the customs.
22 What then? The assembly must
certainly meet, for they will hear that you
have come.
23 Therefore do what we tell you. We
have four men who have taken a vow.
24 Take them and purify yourself with
them, and pay their expenses for them,
that they may shave their heads. Then all
will know that there is no truth in the
things that they have been informed
about you, but that you yourself also walk
keeping the law.
25 But concerning the Gentiles who
believe, we have written our decision that
they should observe no such thing, except
that they should keep themselves from
food offered to idols, from blood, from
strangled things, and from sexual
immorality."
26 Then Paul took the men, and the next
day purified himself and went with them
into the temple, declaring the fulfillment
of the days of purification, until the
offering was offered for every one of
them.
27 When the seven days were almost
completed, the Jews from Asia, when they
saw him in the temple, stirred up all the
multitude and laid hands on him,
28 crying out, "Men of Israel, help! This
is the man who teaches all men
everywhere against the people, and the
law, and this place. Moreover, he also
brought Greeks into the temple and has
defiled this holy place!"
29 For they had seen Trophimus the
Ephesian with him in the city, and they
supposed that Paul had brought him into
the temple.
30 All the city was moved and the people
ran together. They seized Paul and
dragged him out of the temple.
Immediately the doors were shut.
31 As they were trying to kill him, news
came up to the commanding officer of the
regiment that all Jerusalem was in an
uproar.
32 Immediately he took soldiers and
centurions and ran down to them. They,

when they saw the chief captain and the soldiers, stopped beating Paul.
33 Then the commanding officer came near, arrested him, commanded him to be bound with two chains, and inquired who he was and what he had done.
34 Some shouted one thing and some another, among the crowd. When he couldn't find out the truth because of the noise, he commanded him to be brought into the barracks.
35 When he came to the stairs, he was carried by the soldiers because of the violence of the crowd;
36 for the multitude of the people followed after, crying out, "Away with him!"
37 As Paul was about to be brought into the barracks, he asked the commanding officer, "May I speak to you?"
He said, "Do you know Greek?
38 Aren't you then the Egyptian who before these days stirred up to sedition and led out into the wilderness the four thousand men of the Assassins?"
39 But Paul said, "I am a Jew from Tarsus in Cilicia, a citizen of no insignificant city. I beg you, allow me to speak to the people."
40 When he had given him permission, Paul, standing on the stairs, beckoned with his hand to the people. When there was a great silence, he spoke to them in the Hebrew language, saying,

22

1 "Brothers and fathers, listen to the defense which I now make to you."
2 When they heard that he spoke to them in the Hebrew language, they were even more quiet.
He said,
3 "I am indeed a Jew, born in Tarsus of Cilicia, but brought up in this city at the feet of Gamaliel, instructed according to the strict tradition of the law of our fathers, being zealous for God, even as you all are today.
4 I persecuted this Way to the death, binding and delivering into prisons both men and women,
5 as also the high priest and all the council of the elders testify, from whom also I received letters to the brothers, and traveled to Damascus to bring them also who were there to Jerusalem in bonds to be punished.
6 "As I made my journey and came close to Damascus, about noon suddenly a great light shone around me from the sky.
7 I fell to the ground and heard a voice saying to me, 'Saul, Saul, why are you persecuting me?'
8 I answered, 'Who are you, Lord?' He said to me, 'I am Jesus of Nazareth, whom you persecute.'
9 "Those who were with me indeed saw the light and were afraid, but they didn't understand the voice of him who spoke to me.
10 I said, 'What shall I do, Lord?' The Lord said to me, 'Arise, and go into Damascus. There you will be told about all things which are appointed for you to do.'
11 When I couldn't see for the glory of that light, being led by the hand of those who were with me, I came into Damascus.
12 "One Ananias, a devout man according to the law, well reported of by all the Jews who lived in Damascus,
13 came to me, and standing by me said to me, 'Brother Saul, receive your sight!' In that very hour I looked up at him.
14 He said, 'The God of our fathers has appointed you to know his will, and to see the Righteous One, and to hear a voice from his mouth.
15 For you will be a witness for him to all men of what you have seen and heard.
16 Now why do you wait? Arise, be baptized, and wash away your sins, calling on the name of the Lord.'
17 "When I had returned to Jerusalem and while I prayed in the temple, I fell into a trance
18 and saw him saying to me, 'Hurry and get out of Jerusalem quickly, because they will not receive testimony concerning me from you.'
19 I said, 'Lord, they themselves know that I imprisoned and beat in every synagogue those who believed in you.

20 When the blood of Stephen, your
witness, was shed, I also was standing by,
consenting to his death, and guarding the
cloaks of those who killed him.'
21 "He said to me, 'Depart, for I will send
you out far from here to the Gentiles.' "
22 They listened to him until he said
that; then they lifted up their voice and
said, "Rid the earth of this fellow, for he
isn't fit to live!"
23 As they cried out, threw off their
cloaks, and threw dust into the air,
24 the commanding officer commanded
him to be brought into the barracks,
ordering him to be examined by
scourging, that he might know for what
crime they shouted against him like that.
25 When they had tied him up with
straps, Paul asked the centurion who
stood by, "Is it lawful for you to scourge a
man who is a Roman, and not found
guilty?"
26 When the centurion heard it, he went
to the commanding officer and told him,
"Watch what you are about to do, for this
man is a Roman!"
27 The commanding officer came and
asked him, "Tell me, are you a Roman?"
He said, "Yes."
28 The commanding officer answered, "I
bought my citizenship for a great price."
Paul said, "But I was born a Roman."
29 Immediately those who were about to
examine him departed from him, and the
commanding officer also was afraid when
he realized that he was a Roman, because
he had bound him.
30 But on the next day, desiring to know
the truth about why he was accused by
the Jews, he freed him from the bonds and
commanded the chief priests and all the
council to come together, and brought
Paul down and set him before them.

23

1 Paul, looking steadfastly at the council,
said, "Brothers, I have lived before God in
all good conscience until today."
2 The high priest, Ananias, commanded
those who stood by him to strike him on
the mouth.
3 Then Paul said to him, "God will strike
you, you whitewashed wall! Do you sit to
judge me according to the law, and
command me to be struck contrary to the
law?"
4 Those who stood by said, "Do you
malign God's high priest?"
5 Paul said, "I didn't know, brothers,
that he was high priest. For it is written,
'You shall not speak evil of a ruler of your
people.' "*
6 But when Paul perceived that the one
part were Sadducees and the other
Pharisees, he cried out in the council,
"Men and brothers, I am a Pharisee, a son
of Pharisees. Concerning the hope and
resurrection of the dead I am being
judged!"
7 When he had said this, an argument
arose between the Pharisees and
Sadducees, and the crowd was divided.
8 For the Sadducees say that there is no
resurrection, nor angel, nor spirit; but the
Pharisees confess all of these.
9 A great clamor arose, and some of the
scribes of the Pharisees' part stood up,
and contended, saying, "We find no evil in
this man. But if a spirit or angel has
spoken to him, let's not fight against God!"
10 When a great argument arose, the
commanding officer, fearing that Paul
would be torn in pieces by them,
commanded the soldiers to go down and
take him by force from among them and
bring him into the barracks.
11 The following night, the Lord stood by
him and said, "Cheer up, Paul, for as you
have testified about me at Jerusalem, so
you must testify also at Rome."
12 When it was day, some of the Jews
banded together and bound themselves
under a curse, saying that they would
neither eat nor drink until they had killed
Paul.
13 There were more than forty people
who had made this conspiracy.
14 They came to the chief priests and the
elders, and said, "We have bound
ourselves under a great curse to taste
nothing until we have killed Paul.

* **23:5** Exodus 22:28

15 Now therefore, you with the council
inform the commanding officer that he
should bring him down to you tomorrow,
as though you were going to judge his case
more exactly. We are ready to kill him
before he comes near."
16 But Paul's sister's son heard they
were lying in wait, and he came and
entered into the barracks and told Paul.
17 Paul summoned one of the centurions
and said, "Bring this young man to the
commanding officer, for he has
something to tell him."
18 So he took him and brought him to
the commanding officer and said, "Paul,
the prisoner, summoned me and asked
me to bring this young man to you. He has
something to tell you."
19 The commanding officer took him by
the hand, and going aside, asked him
privately, "What is it that you have to tell
me?"
20 He said, "The Jews have agreed to ask
you to bring Paul down to the council
tomorrow, as though intending to inquire
somewhat more accurately concerning
him.
21 Therefore don't yield to them, for
more than forty men lie in wait for him,
who have bound themselves under a
curse to neither eat nor drink until they
have killed him. Now they are ready,
looking for the promise from you."
22 So the commanding officer let the
young man go, charging him, "Tell no one
that you have revealed these things to
me."
23 He called to himself two of the
centurions, and said, "Prepare two
hundred soldiers to go as far as Caesarea,
with seventy horsemen and two hundred
men armed with spears, at the third hour
of the night."†
24 He asked them to provide mounts,
that they might set Paul on one, and bring
him safely to Felix the governor.
25 He wrote a letter like this:
26 "Claudius Lysias to the most excellent
governor Felix: Greetings.
27 "This man was seized by the Jews, and
was about to be killed by them when I
came with the soldiers and rescued him,
having learned that he was a Roman.
28 Desiring to know the cause why they
accused him, I brought him down to their
council.
29 I found him to be accused about
questions of their law, but not to be
charged with anything worthy of death or
of imprisonment.
30 When I was told that the Jews lay in
wait for the man, I sent him to you
immediately, charging his accusers also to
bring their accusations against him
before you. Farewell."
31 So the soldiers, carrying out their
orders, took Paul and brought him by
night to Antipatris.
32 But on the next day they left the
horsemen to go with him, and returned to
the barracks.
33 When they came to Caesarea and
delivered the letter to the governor, they
also presented Paul to him.
34 When the governor had read it, he
asked what province he was from. When
he understood that he was from Cilicia, he
said,
35 "I will hear you fully when your
accusers also arrive." He commanded
that he be kept in Herod's palace.

24

1 After five days, the high priest,
Ananias, came down with certain elders
and an orator, one Tertullus. They
informed the governor against Paul.
2 When he was called, Tertullus began
to accuse him, saying, "Seeing that by you
we enjoy much peace, and that prosperity
is coming to this nation by your foresight,
3 we accept it in all ways and in all
places, most excellent Felix, with all
thankfulness.
4 But that I don't delay you, I entreat you
to bear with us and hear a few words.
5 For we have found this man to be a
plague, an instigator of insurrections
among all the Jews throughout the world,

† **23:23** about 9:00 p.m. † **24:6** TR adds "We wanted to judge him according to our law,"

and a ringleader of the sect of the Nazarenes.
6 He even tried to profane the temple,
and we arrested him.†
7 ‡
8 §By examining him yourself you may
ascertain all these things of which we
accuse him."
9 The Jews also joined in the attack,
affirming that these things were so.
10 When the governor had beckoned to
him to speak, Paul answered, "Because I
know that you have been a judge of this
nation for many years, I cheerfully make
my defense,
11 seeing that you can verify that it is not
more than twelve days since I went up to
worship at Jerusalem.
12 In the temple they didn't find me
disputing with anyone or stirring up a
crowd, either in the synagogues or in the
city.
13 Nor can they prove to you the things
of which they now accuse me.
14 But this I confess to you, that
according to the Way, which they call a
sect, so I serve the God of our fathers,
believing all things which are according
to the law, and which are written in the
prophets;
15 having hope toward God, which these
also themselves look for, that there will be
a resurrection of the dead, both of the just
and unjust.
16 In this I also practice always having a
conscience void of offense toward God
and men.
17 Now after some years, I came to bring
gifts for the needy to my nation, and
offerings;
18 amid which certain Jews from Asia
found me purified in the temple, not with
a mob, nor with turmoil.
19 They ought to have been here before
you and to make accusation if they had
anything against me.
20 Or else let these men themselves say
what injustice they found in me when I
stood before the council,
21 unless it is for this one thing that I
cried standing among them, 'Concerning
the resurrection of the dead I am being
judged before you today!' "
22 But Felix, having more exact
knowledge concerning the Way, deferred
them, saying, "When Lysias, the
commanding officer, comes down, I will
decide your case."
23 He ordered the centurion that Paul
should be kept in custody and should have
some privileges, and not to forbid any of
his friends to serve him or to visit him.
24 After some days, Felix came with
Drusilla his wife, who was a Jewess, and
sent for Paul and heard him concerning
the faith in Christ Jesus.
25 As he reasoned about righteousness,
self-control, and the judgment to come,
Felix was terrified, and answered, "Go
your way for this time, and when it is
convenient for me, I will summon you."
26 Meanwhile, he also hoped that money
would be given to him by Paul, that he
might release him. Therefore also he sent
for him more often and talked with him.
27 But when two years were fulfilled,
Felix was succeeded by Porcius Festus,
and desiring to gain favor with the Jews,
Felix left Paul in bonds.

25

1 Festus therefore, having come into the
province, after three days went up to
Jerusalem from Caesarea.
2 Then the high priest and the principal
men of the Jews informed him against
Paul, and they begged him,
3 asking a favor against him, that he
would summon him to Jerusalem, plotting
to kill him on the way.
4 However Festus answered that Paul
should be kept in custody at Caesarea, and
that he himself was about to depart
shortly.
5 "Let them therefore", he said, "that are
in power among you go down with me,
and if there is anything wrong in the man,
let them accuse him."

‡ **24:7** TR adds "but the commanding officer, Lysias, came by and with great violence took him out of our hands,"
§ **24:8** TR adds "commanding his accusers to come to you."

6 When he had stayed among them
more than ten days, he went down to
Caesarea, and on the next day he sat on
the judgment seat, and commanded Paul
to be brought.
7 When he had come, the Jews who had
come down from Jerusalem stood around
him, bringing against him many and
grievous charges which they could not
prove,
8 while he said in his defense, "Neither
against the law of the Jews, nor against
the temple, nor against Caesar, have I
sinned at all."
9 But Festus, desiring to gain favor with
the Jews, answered Paul and said, "Are
you willing to go up to Jerusalem and be
judged by me there concerning these
things?"
10 But Paul said, "I am standing before
Caesar's judgment seat, where I ought to
be tried. I have done no wrong to the
Jews, as you also know very well.
11 For if I have done wrong and have
committed anything worthy of death, I
don't refuse to die; but if none of those
things is true that they accuse me of, no
one can give me up to them. I appeal to
Caesar!"
12 Then Festus, when he had conferred
with the council, answered, "You have
appealed to Caesar. To Caesar you shall
go."
13 Now when some days had passed,
King Agrippa and Bernice arrived at
Caesarea and greeted Festus.
14 As he stayed there many days, Festus
laid Paul's case before the king, saying,
"There is a certain man left a prisoner by
Felix;
15 about whom, when I was at
Jerusalem, the chief priests and the elders
of the Jews informed me, asking for a
sentence against him.
16 I answered them that it is not the
custom of the Romans to give up any man
to destruction before the accused has met
the accusers face to face and has had
opportunity to make his defense
concerning the matter laid against him.
17 When therefore they had come
together here, I didn't delay, but on the
next day sat on the judgment seat and
commanded the man to be brought.
18 When the accusers stood up, they
brought no charges against him of such
things as I supposed;
19 but had certain questions against him
about their own religion and about one
Jesus, who was dead, whom Paul affirmed
to be alive.
20 Being perplexed how to inquire
concerning these things, I asked whether
he was willing to go to Jerusalem and
there be judged concerning these matters.
21 But when Paul had appealed to be
kept for the decision of the emperor, I
commanded him to be kept until I could
send him to Caesar."
22 Agrippa said to Festus, "I also would
like to hear the man myself."
"Tomorrow," he said, "you shall hear
him."
23 So on the next day, when Agrippa and
Bernice had come with great pomp, and
they had entered into the place of hearing
with the commanding officers and the
principal men of the city, at the command
of Festus, Paul was brought in.
24 Festus said, "King Agrippa, and all
men who are here present with us, you
see this man about whom all the
multitude of the Jews petitioned me, both
at Jerusalem and here, crying that he
ought not to live any longer.
25 But when I found that he had
committed nothing worthy of death, and
as he himself appealed to the emperor, I
determined to send him,
26 of whom I have no certain thing to
write to my lord. Therefore I have
brought him out before you, and
especially before you, King Agrippa, that,
after examination I may have something
to write.
27 For it seems to me unreasonable, in
sending a prisoner, not to also specify the
charges against him."

26

1 Agrippa said to Paul, "You may speak
for yourself."
Then Paul stretched out his hand, and
made his defense.

2 “I think myself happy, King Agrippa,
that I am to make my defense before you
today concerning all the things that I am
accused by the Jews,
3 especially because you are expert in
all customs and questions which are
among the Jews. Therefore I beg you to
hear me patiently.
4 “Indeed, all the Jews know my way of
life from my youth up, which was from
the beginning among my own nation and
at Jerusalem;
5 having known me from the first, if
they are willing to testify, that after the
strictest sect of our religion I lived a
Pharisee.
6 Now I stand here to be judged for the
hope of the promise made by God to our
fathers,
7 which our twelve tribes, earnestly
serving night and day, hope to attain.
Concerning this hope I am accused by the
Jews, King Agrippa!
8 Why is it judged incredible with you if
God does raise the dead?
9 “I myself most certainly thought that I
ought to do many things contrary to the
name of Jesus of Nazareth.
10 I also did this in Jerusalem. I both
shut up many of the saints in prisons,
having received authority from the chief
priests; and when they were put to death I
gave my vote against them.
11 Punishing them often in all the
synagogues, I tried to make them
blaspheme. Being exceedingly enraged
against them, I persecuted them even to
foreign cities.
12 “Whereupon as I traveled to
Damascus with the authority and
commission from the chief priests,
13 at noon, O king, I saw on the way a
light from the sky, brighter than the sun,
shining around me and those who
traveled with me.
14 When we had all fallen to the earth, I
heard a voice saying to me in the Hebrew
language, ‘Saul, Saul, why are you
persecuting me? It is hard for you to kick
against the goads.’
15 “I said, ‘Who are you, Lord?’

“He said, ‘I am Jesus, whom you are
persecuting.
16 But arise, and stand on your feet, for I
have appeared to you for this purpose: to
appoint you a servant and a witness both
of the things which you have seen and of
the things which I will reveal to you;
17 delivering you from the people and
from the Gentiles, to whom I send you,
18 to open their eyes, that they may turn
from darkness to light and from the
power of Satan to God, that they may
receive remission of sins and an
inheritance among those who are
sanctified by faith in me.’
19 “Therefore, King Agrippa, I was not
disobedient to the heavenly vision,
20 but declared first to them of
Damascus, at Jerusalem, and throughout
all the country of Judea, and also to the
Gentiles, that they should repent and turn
to God, doing works worthy of
repentance.
21 For this reason the Jews seized me in
the temple and tried to kill me.
22 Having therefore obtained the help
that is from God, I stand to this day
testifying both to small and great, saying
nothing but what the prophets and Moses
said would happen,
23 how the Christ must suffer, and how,
by the resurrection of the dead, he would
be first to proclaim light both to these
people and to the Gentiles.”
24 As he thus made his defense, Festus
said with a loud voice, “Paul, you are
crazy! Your great learning is driving you
insane!”
25 But he said, “I am not crazy, most
excellent Festus, but boldly declare words
of truth and reasonableness.
26 For the king knows of these things, to
whom also I speak freely. For I am
persuaded that none of these things is
hidden from him, for this has not been
done in a corner.
27 King Agrippa, do you believe the
prophets? I know that you believe.”
28 Agrippa said to Paul, “With a little
persuasion are you trying to make me a
Christian?”

29 Paul said, “I pray to God, that whether
with little or with much, not only you, but
also all that hear me today, might become
such as I am, except for these bonds.”
30 The king rose up with the governor
and Bernice, and those who sat with them.
31 When they had withdrawn, they
spoke to one another, saying, “This man
does nothing worthy of death or of
bonds.”
32 Agrippa said to Festus, “This man
might have been set free if he had not
appealed to Caesar.”

27

1 When it was determined that we
should sail for Italy, they delivered Paul
and certain other prisoners to a centurion
named Julius, of the Augustan band.
2 Embarking in a ship of Adramyttium,
which was about to sail to places on the
coast of Asia, we put to sea, Aristarchus, a
Macedonian of Thessalonica being with
us.
3 The next day, we touched at Sidon.
Julius treated Paul kindly and gave him
permission to go to his friends and refresh
himself.
4 Putting to sea from there, we sailed
under the lee of Cyprus, because the
winds were contrary.
5 When we had sailed across the sea
which is off Cilicia and Pamphylia, we
came to Myra, a city of Lycia.
6 There the centurion found a ship of
Alexandria sailing for Italy, and he put us
on board.
7 When we had sailed slowly many
days, and had come with difficulty
opposite Cnidus, the wind not allowing us
further, we sailed under the lee of Crete,
opposite Salmone.
8 With difficulty sailing along it we
came to a certain place called Fair
Havens, near the city of Lasea.
9 When much time had passed and the
voyage was now dangerous because the
Fast had now already gone by, Paul
admonished them
10 and said to them, “Sirs, I perceive that
the voyage will be with injury and much
loss, not only of the cargo and the ship,
but also of our lives.”
11 But the centurion gave more heed to
the master and to the owner of the ship
than to those things which were spoken
by Paul.
12 Because the haven was not suitable to
winter in, the majority advised going to
sea from there, if by any means they could
reach Phoenix and winter there, which is
a port of Crete, looking southwest and
northwest.
13 When the south wind blew softly,
supposing that they had obtained their
purpose, they weighed anchor and sailed
along Crete, close to shore.
14 But before long, a stormy wind beat
down from shore, which is called
Euroclydon.†
15 When the ship was caught and
couldn’t face the wind, we gave way to it
and were driven along.
16 Running under the lee of a small
island called Clauda, we were able, with
difficulty, to secure the boat.
17 After they had hoisted it up, they used
cables to help reinforce the ship. Fearing
that they would run aground on the Syrtis
sand bars, they lowered the sea anchor,
and so were driven along.
18 As we labored exceedingly with the
storm, the next day they began to throw
things overboard.
19 On the third day, they threw out the
ship’s tackle with their own hands.
20 When neither sun nor stars shone on
us for many days, and no small storm
pressed on us, all hope that we would be
saved was now taken away.
21 When they had been long without
food, Paul stood up in the middle of them
and said, “Sirs, you should have listened
to me, and not have set sail from Crete
and have gotten this injury and loss.
22 Now I exhort you to cheer up, for
there will be no loss of life among you, but
only of the ship.
23 For there stood by me this night an
angel, belonging to the God whose I am
and whom I serve,

† **27:14** Or, “a northeaster”.

24 saying, ‘Don’t be afraid, Paul. You
must stand before Caesar. Behold, God
has granted you all those who sail with
you.’
25 Therefore, sirs, cheer up! For I
believe God, that it will be just as it has
been spoken to me.
26 But we must run aground on a certain
island.”
27 But when the fourteenth night had
come, as we were driven back and forth
in the Adriatic Sea, about midnight the
sailors surmised that they were drawing
near to some land.
28 They took soundings and found
twenty fathoms.‡ After a little while, they
took soundings again, and found fifteen
fathoms.§
29 Fearing that we would run aground
on rocky ground, they let go four anchors
from the stern, and wished for daylight.
30 As the sailors were trying to flee out
of the ship and had lowered the boat into
the sea, pretending that they would lay
out anchors from the bow,
31 Paul said to the centurion and to the
soldiers, “Unless these stay in the ship,
you can’t be saved.”
32 Then the soldiers cut away the ropes
of the boat and let it fall off.
33 While the day was coming on, Paul
begged them all to take some food, saying,
“Today is the fourteenth day that you wait
and continue fasting, having taken
nothing.
34 Therefore I beg you to take some food,
for this is for your safety; for not a hair
will perish from any of your heads.”
35 When he had said this and had taken
bread, he gave thanks to God in the
presence of all; then he broke it and began
to eat.
36 Then they all cheered up, and they
also took food.
37 In all, we were two hundred
seventy-six souls on the ship.
38 When they had eaten enough, they
lightened the ship, throwing out the
wheat into the sea.
39 When it was day, they didn’t
recognize the land, but they noticed a
certain bay with a beach, and they
decided to try to drive the ship onto it.
40 Casting off the anchors, they left them
in the sea, at the same time untying the
rudder ropes. Hoisting up the foresail to
the wind, they made for the beach.
41 But coming to a place where two seas
met, they ran the vessel aground. The
bow struck and remained immovable, but
the stern began to break up by the
violence of the waves.
42 The soldiers’ counsel was to kill the
prisoners, so that none of them would
swim out and escape.
43 But the centurion, desiring to save
Paul, stopped them from their purpose,
and commanded that those who could
swim should throw themselves overboard
first to go toward the land;
44 and the rest should follow, some on
planks and some on other things from the
ship. So they all escaped safely to the land.

28

1 When we had escaped, then they†
learned that the island was called Malta.
2 The natives showed us uncommon
kindness; for they kindled a fire and
received us all, because of the present
rain and because of the cold.
3 But when Paul had gathered a bundle
of sticks and laid them on the fire, a viper
came out because of the heat and fastened
on his hand.
4 When the natives saw the creature
hanging from his hand, they said to one
another, “No doubt this man is a
murderer, whom, though he has escaped
from the sea, yet Justice has not allowed to
live.”
5 However he shook off the creature
into the fire, and wasn’t harmed.
6 But they expected that he would have
swollen or fallen down dead suddenly,
but when they watched for a long time
and saw nothing bad happen to him, they
changed their minds and said that he was
a god.

‡ **27:28** 20 fathoms = 120 feet = 36.6 meters § **27:28** 15 fathoms = 90 feet = 27.4 meters † **28:1** NU reads “we”

7 Now in the neighborhood of that place
were lands belonging to the chief man of
the island, named Publius, who received
us and courteously entertained us for
three days.
8 The father of Publius lay sick of fever
and dysentery. Paul entered in to him,
prayed, and laying his hands on him,
healed him.
9 Then when this was done, the rest also
who had diseases in the island came and
were cured.
10 They also honored us with many
honors; and when we sailed, they put on
board the things that we needed.

11 After three months, we set sail in a
ship of Alexandria which had wintered in
the island, whose figurehead was "The
Twin Brothers."
12 Touching at Syracuse, we stayed there
three days.
13 From there we circled around and
arrived at Rhegium. After one day, a
south wind sprang up, and on the second
day we came to Puteoli,
14 where we found brothers,‡ and were
entreated to stay with them for seven
days. So we came to Rome.
15 From there the brothers, when they
heard of us, came to meet us as far as The
Market of Appius and The Three Taverns.
When Paul saw them, he thanked God and
took courage.
16 When we entered into Rome, the
centurion delivered the prisoners to the
captain of the guard, but Paul was
allowed to stay by himself with the soldier
who guarded him.

17 After three days Paul called together
those who were the leaders of the Jews.
When they had come together, he said to
them, "I, brothers, though I had done
nothing against the people or the customs
of our fathers, still was delivered prisoner
from Jerusalem into the hands of the
Romans,
18 who, when they had examined me,
desired to set me free, because there was
no cause of death in me.
19 But when the Jews spoke against it, I
was constrained to appeal to Caesar, not
that I had anything about which to accuse
my nation.
20 For this cause therefore I asked to see
you and to speak with you. For because of
the hope of Israel I am bound with this
chain."
21 They said to him, "We neither
received letters from Judea concerning
you, nor did any of the brothers come
here and report or speak any evil of you.
22 But we desire to hear from you what
you think. For, as concerning this sect, it is
known to us that everywhere it is spoken
against."
23 When they had appointed him a day,
many people came to him at his lodging.
He explained to them, testifying about
God's Kingdom, and persuading them
concerning Jesus, both from the law of
Moses and from the prophets, from
morning until evening.
24 Some believed the things which were
spoken, and some disbelieved.
25 When they didn't agree among
themselves, they departed after Paul had
spoken one message: "The Holy Spirit
spoke rightly through Isaiah the prophet
to our fathers,
26 saying,
'Go to this people and say,
in hearing, you will hear,
but will in no way understand.
In seeing, you will see,
but will in no way perceive.
27 For this people's heart has grown
callous.
Their ears are dull of hearing.
Their eyes they have closed.
Lest they should see with their eyes,
hear with their ears,
understand with their heart,
and would turn again,
then I would heal them.'*
28 "Be it known therefore to you that the
salvation of God is sent to the nations, and
they will listen."

‡ **28:14** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **28:27** Isaiah 6:9-10 § **28:29** NU omits verse 29.

29 When he had said these words, the
Jews departed, having a great dispute
among themselves.§
30 Paul stayed two whole years in his
own rented house and received all who
were coming to him,
31 preaching God's Kingdom and
teaching the things concerning the Lord
Jesus Christ with all boldness, without
hindrance.

Paul's Letter to the Romans

1 Paul, a servant of Jesus Christ,† called
to be an apostle, set apart for the Good
News of God,
2 which he promised before through his
prophets in the holy Scriptures,
3 concerning his Son, who was born of
the offspring‡ of David according to the
flesh,
4 who was declared to be the Son of God
with power according to the Spirit of
holiness, by the resurrection from the
dead, Jesus Christ our Lord,
5 through whom we received grace and
apostleship for obedience of faith among
all the nations for his name's sake;
6 among whom you are also called to
belong to Jesus Christ;
7 to all who are in Rome, beloved of God,
called to be saints: Grace to you and peace
from God our Father and the Lord Jesus
Christ.
8 First, I thank my God through Jesus
Christ for all of you, that your faith is
proclaimed throughout the whole world.
9 For God is my witness, whom I serve in
my spirit in the Good News of his Son,
how unceasingly I make mention of you
always in my prayers,
10 requesting, if by any means now at
last I may be prospered by the will of God
to come to you.
11 For I long to see you, that I may
impart to you some spiritual gift, to the
end that you may be established;
12 that is, that I with you may be
encouraged in you, each of us by the
other's faith, both yours and mine.
13 Now I don't desire to have you
unaware, brothers, that I often planned to
come to you (and was hindered so far),
that I might have some fruit among you
also, even as among the rest of the
Gentiles.
14 I am debtor both to Greeks and to
foreigners, both to the wise and to the
foolish.
15 So as much as is in me, I am eager to
preach the Good News to you also who are
in Rome.
16 For I am not ashamed of the Good
News of Christ, because it is the power of
God for salvation for everyone who
believes, for the Jew first, and also for the
Greek.
17 For in it is revealed God's
righteousness from faith to faith. As it is
written, "But the righteous shall live by
faith."*
18 For the wrath of God is revealed from
heaven against all ungodliness and
unrighteousness of men who suppress the
truth in unrighteousness,
19 because that which is known of God is
revealed in them, for God revealed it to
them.
20 For the invisible things of him since
the creation of the world are clearly seen,
being perceived through the things that
are made, even his everlasting power and
divinity, that they may be without excuse.
21 Because knowing God, they didn't
glorify him as God, and didn't give thanks,
but became vain in their reasoning, and
their senseless heart was darkened.
22 Professing themselves to be wise,
they became fools,
23 and traded the glory of the
incorruptible God for the likeness of an
image of corruptible man, and of birds,
four-footed animals, and creeping things.
24 Therefore God also gave them up in
the lusts of their hearts to uncleanness,
that their bodies should be dishonored
among themselves;
25 who exchanged the truth of God for a
lie, and worshiped and served the
creature rather than the Creator, who is
blessed forever. Amen.
26 For this reason, God gave them up to
vile passions. For their women changed
the natural function into that which is
against nature.
27 Likewise also the men, leaving the
natural function of the woman, burned in

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:3** or, seed * **1:17** Habakkuk 2:4

their lust toward one another, men doing
what is inappropriate with men, and
receiving in themselves the due penalty of
their error.
28 Even as they refused to have God in
their knowledge, God gave them up to a
reprobate mind, to do those things which
are not fitting;
29 being filled with all unrighteousness,
sexual immorality, wickedness,
covetousness, malice; full of envy,
murder, strife, deceit, evil habits, secret
slanderers,
30 backbiters, hateful to God, insolent,
arrogant, boastful, inventors of evil
things, disobedient to parents,
31 without understanding, covenant
breakers, without natural affection,
unforgiving, unmerciful;
32 who, knowing the ordinance of God,
that those who practice such things are
worthy of death, not only do the same, but
also approve of those who practice them.

2

1 Therefore you are without excuse, O
man, whoever you are who judge. For in
that which you judge another, you
condemn yourself. For you who judge
practice the same things.
2 We know that the judgment of God is
according to truth against those who
practice such things.
3 Do you think this, O man who judges
those who practice such things, and do the
same, that you will escape the judgment
of God?
4 Or do you despise the riches of his
goodness, forbearance, and patience, not
knowing that the goodness of God leads
you to repentance?
5 But according to your hardness and
unrepentant heart you are treasuring up
for yourself wrath in the day of wrath,
revelation, and of the righteous judgment
of God,
6 who "will pay back to everyone
according to their works:"*
7 to those who by perseverance in
well-doing seek for glory, honor, and
incorruptibility, eternal life;
8 but to those who are self-seeking and
don't obey the truth, but obey
unrighteousness, will be wrath,
indignation,
9 oppression, and anguish on every soul
of man who does evil, to the Jew first, and
also to the Greek.
10 But glory, honor, and peace go to
every man who does good, to the Jew first,
and also to the Greek.
11 For there is no partiality with God.
12 For as many as have sinned without
the law will also perish without the law.
As many as have sinned under the law
will be judged by the law.
13 For it isn't the hearers of the law who
are righteous before God, but the doers of
the law will be justified
14 (for when Gentiles who don't have the
law do by nature the things of the law,
these, not having the law, are a law to
themselves,
15 in that they show the work of the law
written in their hearts, their conscience
testifying with them, and their thoughts
among themselves accusing or else
excusing them)
16 in the day when God will judge the
secrets of men, according to my Good
News, by Jesus Christ.
17 Indeed you bear the name of a Jew,
rest on the law, glory in God,
18 know his will, and approve the things
that are excellent, being instructed out of
the law,
19 and are confident that you yourself
are a guide of the blind, a light to those
who are in darkness,
20 a corrector of the foolish, a teacher of
babies, having in the law the form of
knowledge and of the truth.
21 You therefore who teach another,
don't you teach yourself? You who preach
that a man shouldn't steal, do you steal?
22 You who say a man shouldn't commit
adultery, do you commit adultery? You
who abhor idols, do you rob temples?

* **2:6** Psalms 62:12; Proverbs 24:12

23 You who glory in the law, do you
dishonor God by disobeying the law?
24 For “the name of God is blasphemed
among the Gentiles because of you,”* just
as it is written.
25 For circumcision indeed profits, if
you are a doer of the law, but if you are a
transgressor of the law, your circumcision
has become uncircumcision.
26 If therefore the uncircumcised keep
the ordinances of the law, won’t his
uncircumcision be accounted as
circumcision?
27 Won’t those who are physically
uncircumcised, but fulfill the law, judge
you, who with the letter and circumcision
are a transgressor of the law?
28 For he is not a Jew who is one
outwardly, neither is that circumcision
which is outward in the flesh;
29 but he is a Jew who is one inwardly,
and circumcision is that of the heart, in
the spirit, not in the letter; whose praise is
not from men, but from God.

3

1 Then what advantage does the Jew
have? Or what is the profit of
circumcision?
2 Much in every way! Because first of
all, they were entrusted with the
revelations of God.
3 For what if some were without faith?
Will their lack of faith nullify the
faithfulness of God?
4 May it never be! Yes, let God be found
true, but every man a liar. As it is written,
“that you might be justified in your words,
and might prevail when you come
into judgment.”*
5 But if our unrighteousness commends
the righteousness of God, what will we
say? Is God unrighteous who inflicts
wrath? I speak like men do.
6 May it never be! For then how will God
judge the world?
7 For if the truth of God through my lie
abounded to his glory, why am I also still
judged as a sinner?
8 Why not (as we are slanderously
reported, and as some affirm that we say),
“Let’s do evil, that good may come?”
Those who say so are justly condemned.
9 What then? Are we better than they?
No, in no way. For we previously warned
both Jews and Greeks that they are all
under sin.
10 As it is written,
“There is no one righteous;
no, not one.
11 There is no one who understands.
There is no one who seeks after God.
12 They have all turned away.
They have together become
unprofitable.
There is no one who does good,
no, not so much as one.”*
13 “Their throat is an open tomb.
With their tongues they have used
deceit.”*
“The poison of vipers is under their lips.”*
14 “Their mouth is full of cursing and
bitterness.”*
15 “Their feet are swift to shed blood.
16 Destruction and misery are in their
ways.
17 The way of peace, they haven’t
known.”*
18 “There is no fear of God before their
eyes.”*
19 Now we know that whatever things
the law says, it speaks to those who are
under the law, that every mouth may be
closed, and all the world may be brought
under the judgment of God.
20 Because by the works of the law, no
flesh will be justified in his sight; for
through the law comes the knowledge of
sin.
21 But now apart from the law, a
righteousness of God has been revealed,
being testified by the law and the
prophets;
22 even the righteousness of God
through faith in Jesus Christ to all and on
all those who believe. For there is no
distinction,

* **2:24** Isaiah 52:5; Ezekiel 36:22 * **3:4** Psalms 51:4 * **3:12** Psalms 14:1-3; 53:1-3; Ecclesiastes 7:20 * **3:13** Psalms 5:9 * **3:13** Psalms 140:3 * **3:14** Psalms 10:7 * **3:17** Isaiah 59:7-8 * **3:18** Psalms 36:1

23 for all have sinned, and fall short of
the glory of God;
24 being justified freely by his grace
through the redemption that is in Christ
Jesus,
25 whom God sent to be an atoning
sacrifice† through faith in his blood, for a
demonstration of his righteousness
through the passing over of prior sins, in
God's forbearance;
26 to demonstrate his righteousness at
this present time, that he might himself be
just and the justifier of him who has faith
in Jesus.

27 Where then is the boasting? It is
excluded. By what kind of law? Of works?
No, but by a law of faith.
28 We maintain therefore that a man is
justified by faith apart from the works of
the law.
29 Or is God the God of Jews only? Isn't
he the God of Gentiles also? Yes, of
Gentiles also,
30 since indeed there is one God who
will justify the circumcised by faith and
the uncircumcised through faith.

31 Do we then nullify the law through
faith? May it never be! No, we establish
the law.

4

1 What then will we say that Abraham,
our forefather, has found according to the
flesh?
2 For if Abraham was justified by works,
he has something to boast about, but not
toward God.
3 For what does the Scripture say?
"Abraham believed God, and it was
accounted to him for righteousness."*
4 Now to him who works, the reward is
not counted as grace, but as something
owed.
5 But to him who doesn't work, but
believes in him who justifies the ungodly,
his faith is accounted for righteousness.
6 Even as David also pronounces
blessing on the man to whom God counts
righteousness apart from works:
7 "Blessed are they whose iniquities are
forgiven,
whose sins are covered.
8 Blessed is the man whom the Lord will
by no means charge with sin."*
9 Is this blessing then pronounced only
on the circumcised, or on the
uncircumcised also? For we say that faith
was accounted to Abraham for
righteousness.
10 How then was it counted? When he
was in circumcision, or in
uncircumcision? Not in circumcision, but
in uncircumcision.
11 He received the sign of circumcision,
a seal of the righteousness of the faith
which he had while he was in
uncircumcision, that he might be the
father of all those who believe, though
they might be in uncircumcision, that
righteousness might also be accounted to
them.
12 He is the father of circumcision to
those who not only are of the
circumcision, but who also walk in the
steps of that faith of our father Abraham,
which he had in uncircumcision.
13 For the promise to Abraham and to
his offspring that he would be heir of the
world wasn't through the law, but
through the righteousness of faith.
14 For if those who are of the law are
heirs, faith is made void, and the promise
is made of no effect.
15 For the law produces wrath; for
where there is no law, neither is there
disobedience.
16 For this cause it is of faith, that it may
be according to grace, to the end that the
promise may be sure to all the offspring,
not to that only which is of the law, but to
that also which is of the faith of Abraham,
who is the father of us all.
17 As it is written, "I have made you a
father of many nations."* This is in the
presence of him whom he believed: God,
who gives life to the dead, and calls the
things that are not, as though they were.
18 Against hope, Abraham in hope
believed, to the end that he might become
a father of many nations, according to

† **3:25** or, a propitiation * **4:3** Genesis 15:6 * **4:8** Psalms 32:1-2 * **4:17** Genesis 17:5 * **4:18** Genesis 15:5

that which had been spoken, “So will your offspring be.”*
19 Without being weakened in faith, he didn’t consider his own body, already having been worn out, (he being about a hundred years old), and the deadness of Sarah’s womb.
20 Yet, looking to the promise of God, he didn’t waver through unbelief, but grew strong through faith, giving glory to God,
21 and being fully assured that what he had promised, he was also able to perform.
22 Therefore it also was “credited to him for righteousness.”*
23 Now it was not written that it was accounted to him for his sake alone,
24 but for our sake also, to whom it will be accounted, who believe in him who raised Jesus our Lord from the dead,
25 who was delivered up for our trespasses, and was raised for our justification.

5

1 Being therefore justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ;
2 through whom we also have our access by faith into this grace in which we stand. We rejoice in hope of the glory of God.
3 Not only this, but we also rejoice in our sufferings, knowing that suffering produces perseverance;
4 and perseverance, proven character; and proven character, hope;
5 and hope doesn’t disappoint us, because God’s love has been poured into our hearts through the Holy Spirit who was given to us.
6 For while we were yet weak, at the right time Christ died for the ungodly.
7 For one will hardly die for a righteous man. Yet perhaps for a good person someone would even dare to die.
8 But God commends his own love toward us, in that while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us.
9 Much more then, being now justified by his blood, we will be saved from God’s wrath through him.
10 For if while we were enemies, we were reconciled to God through the death of his Son, much more, being reconciled, we will be saved by his life.
11 Not only so, but we also rejoice in God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have now received the reconciliation.
12 Therefore, as sin entered into the world through one man, and death through sin, so death passed to all men because all sinned.
13 For until the law, sin was in the world; but sin is not charged when there is no law.
14 Nevertheless death reigned from Adam until Moses, even over those whose sins weren’t like Adam’s disobedience, who is a foreshadowing of him who was to come.
15 But the free gift isn’t like the trespass. For if by the trespass of the one the many died, much more did the grace of God and the gift by the grace of the one man, Jesus Christ, abound to the many.
16 The gift is not as through one who sinned; for the judgment came by one to condemnation, but the free gift followed many trespasses to justification.
17 For if by the trespass of the one, death reigned through the one; so much more will those who receive the abundance of grace and of the gift of righteousness reign in life through the one, Jesus Christ.
18 So then as through one trespass, all men were condemned; even so through one act of righteousness, all men were justified to life.
19 For as through the one man’s disobedience many were made sinners, even so through the obedience of the one, many will be made righteous.
20 The law came in that the trespass might abound; but where sin abounded, grace abounded more exceedingly,
21 that as sin reigned in death, even so grace might reign through righteousness

* **4:22** Genesis 15:6

to eternal life through Jesus Christ our Lord.

6

1 What shall we say then? Shall we continue in sin, that grace may abound?
2 May it never be! We who died to sin, how could we live in it any longer?
3 Or don't you know that all of us who were baptized into Christ Jesus were baptized into his death?
4 We were buried therefore with him through baptism into death, that just as Christ was raised from the dead through the glory of the Father, so we also might walk in newness of life.
5 For if we have become united with him in the likeness of his death, we will also be part of his resurrection;
6 knowing this, that our old man was crucified with him, that the body of sin might be done away with, so that we would no longer be in bondage to sin.
7 For he who has died has been freed from sin.
8 But if we died with Christ, we believe that we will also live with him,
9 knowing that Christ, being raised from the dead, dies no more. Death no longer has dominion over him!
10 For the death that he died, he died to sin one time; but the life that he lives, he lives to God.
11 Thus consider yourselves also to be dead to sin, but alive to God in Christ Jesus our Lord.
12 Therefore don't let sin reign in your mortal body, that you should obey it in its lusts.
13 Also, do not present your members to sin as instruments of unrighteousness, but present yourselves to God as alive from the dead, and your members as instruments of righteousness to God.
14 For sin will not have dominion over you, for you are not under law, but under grace.
15 What then? Shall we sin because we are not under law but under grace? May it never be!
16 Don't you know that when you present yourselves as servants and obey someone, you are the servants of whomever you obey, whether of sin to death, or of obedience to righteousness?
17 But thanks be to God that, whereas you were bondservants of sin, you became obedient from the heart to that form of teaching to which you were delivered.
18 Being made free from sin, you became bondservants of righteousness.
19 I speak in human terms because of the weakness of your flesh; for as you presented your members as servants to uncleanness and to wickedness upon wickedness, even so now present your members as servants to righteousness for sanctification.
20 For when you were servants of sin, you were free from righteousness.
21 What fruit then did you have at that time in the things of which you are now ashamed? For the end of those things is death.
22 But now, being made free from sin and having become servants of God, you have your fruit of sanctification and the result of eternal life.
23 For the wages of sin is death, but the free gift of God is eternal life in Christ Jesus our Lord.

7

1 Or don't you know, brothers† (for I speak to men who know the law), that the law has dominion over a man for as long as he lives?
2 For the woman that has a husband is bound by law to the husband while he lives, but if the husband dies, she is discharged from the law of the husband.
3 So then if, while the husband lives, she is joined to another man, she would be called an adulteress. But if the husband dies, she is free from the law, so that she is no adulteress, though she is joined to another man.
4 Therefore, my brothers, you also were made dead to the law through the body of

† **7:1** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

Christ, that you would be joined to another, to him who was raised from the dead, that we might produce fruit to God.
5 For when we were in the flesh, the sinful passions which were through the law worked in our members to bring out fruit to death.
6 But now we have been discharged from the law, having died to that in which we were held; so that we serve in newness of the spirit, and not in oldness of the letter.
7 What shall we say then? Is the law sin? May it never be! However, I wouldn't have known sin except through the law. For I wouldn't have known coveting unless the law had said, "You shall not covet."*
8 But sin, finding occasion through the commandment, produced in me all kinds of coveting. For apart from the law, sin is dead.
9 I was alive apart from the law once, but when the commandment came, sin revived and I died.
10 The commandment which was for life, this I found to be for death;
11 for sin, finding occasion through the commandment, deceived me, and through it killed me.
12 Therefore the law indeed is holy, and the commandment holy, righteous, and good.
13 Did then that which is good become death to me? May it never be! But sin, that it might be shown to be sin, was producing death in me through that which is good; that through the commandment sin might become exceedingly sinful.
14 For we know that the law is spiritual, but I am fleshly, sold under sin.
15 For I don't understand what I am doing. For I don't practice what I desire to do; but what I hate, that I do.
16 But if what I don't desire, that I do, I consent to the law that it is good.
17 So now it is no more I that do it, but sin which dwells in me.
18 For I know that in me, that is, in my flesh, dwells no good thing. For desire is present with me, but I don't find it doing that which is good.
19 For the good which I desire, I don't do; but the evil which I don't desire, that I practice.
20 But if what I don't desire, that I do, it is no more I that do it, but sin which dwells in me.
21 I find then the law that, while I desire to do good, evil is present.
22 For I delight in God's law after the inward person,
23 but I see a different law in my members, warring against the law of my mind, and bringing me into captivity under the law of sin which is in my members.
24 What a wretched man I am! Who will deliver me out of the body of this death?
25 I thank God through Jesus Christ, our Lord! So then with the mind, I myself serve God's law, but with the flesh, sin's law.

8

1 There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus, who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit.†
2 For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus made me free from the law of sin and of death.
3 For what the law couldn't do, in that it was weak through the flesh, God did, sending his own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh and for sin, he condemned sin in the flesh,
4 that the ordinance of the law might be fulfilled in us who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit.
5 For those who live according to the flesh set their minds on the things of the flesh, but those who live according to the Spirit, the things of the Spirit.
6 For the mind of the flesh is death, but the mind of the Spirit is life and peace;
7 because the mind of the flesh is hostile toward God, for it is not subject to God's law, neither indeed can it be.
8 Those who are in the flesh can't please God.

* **7:7** Exodus 20:17; Deuteronomy 5:21 † **8:1** NU omits "who don't walk according to the flesh, but according to the Spirit"

9 But you are not in the flesh but in the
Spirit, if it is so that the Spirit of God
dwells in you. But if any man doesn't have
the Spirit of Christ, he is not his.
10 If Christ is in you, the body is dead
because of sin, but the spirit is alive
because of righteousness.
11 But if the Spirit of him who raised up
Jesus from the dead dwells in you, he who
raised up Christ Jesus from the dead will
also give life to your mortal bodies
through his Spirit who dwells in you.
12 So then, brothers, we are debtors, not
to the flesh, to live after the flesh.
13 For if you live after the flesh, you
must die; but if by the Spirit you put to
death the deeds of the body, you will live.
14 For as many as are led by the Spirit of
God, these are children of God.
15 For you didn't receive the spirit of
bondage again to fear, but you received
the Spirit of adoption, by whom we cry,
"Abba!‡ Father!"
16 The Spirit himself testifies with our
spirit that we are children of God;
17 and if children, then heirs—heirs of
God and joint heirs with Christ, if indeed
we suffer with him, that we may also be
glorified with him.
18 For I consider that the sufferings of
this present time are not worthy to be
compared with the glory which will be
revealed toward us.
19 For the creation waits with eager
expectation for the children of God to be
revealed.
20 For the creation was subjected to
vanity, not of its own will, but because of
him who subjected it, in hope
21 that the creation itself also will be
delivered from the bondage of decay into
the liberty of the glory of the children of
God.
22 For we know that the whole creation
groans and travails in pain together until
now.
23 Not only so, but ourselves also, who
have the first fruits of the Spirit, even we
ourselves groan within ourselves, waiting
for adoption, the redemption of our body.
24 For we were saved in hope, but hope
that is seen is not hope. For who hopes for
that which he sees?
25 But if we hope for that which we don't
see, we wait for it with patience.
26 In the same way, the Spirit also helps
our weaknesses, for we don't know how
to pray as we ought. But the Spirit himself
makes intercession for us with groanings
which can't be uttered.
27 He who searches the hearts knows
what is on the Spirit's mind, because he
makes intercession for the saints
according to God.
28 We know that all things work together
for good for those who love God, for those
who are called according to his purpose.
29 For whom he foreknew, he also
predestined to be conformed to the image
of his Son, that he might be the firstborn
among many brothers.§
30 Whom he predestined, those he also
called. Whom he called, those he also
justified. Whom he justified, those he also
glorified.
31 What then shall we say about these
things? If God is for us, who can be
against us?
32 He who didn't spare his own Son, but
delivered him up for us all, how would he
not also with him freely give us all things?
33 Who could bring a charge against
God's chosen ones? It is God who justifies.
34 Who is he who condemns? It is Christ
who died, yes rather, who was raised
from the dead, who is at the right hand of
God, who also makes intercession for us.
35 Who shall separate us from the love
of Christ? Could oppression, or anguish,
or persecution, or famine, or nakedness,
or peril, or sword?
36 Even as it is written,
"For your sake we are killed all day long.
We were accounted as sheep for the
slaughter."*

‡ **8:15** Abba is an Aramaic word for "Father" or "Daddy", which can be used affectionately and respectfully in prayer to our Father in heaven. § **8:29** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **8:36** Psalms 44:22

37 No, in all these things we are more than
conquerors through him who loved us.
38 For I am persuaded that neither death,
nor life, nor angels, nor principalities, nor
things present, nor things to come, nor
powers,
39 nor height, nor depth, nor any other
created thing will be able to separate us
from God's love which is in Christ Jesus
our Lord.

9

1 I tell the truth in Christ. I am not lying,
my conscience testifying with me in the
Holy Spirit
2 that I have great sorrow and
unceasing pain in my heart.
3 For I could wish that I myself were
accursed from Christ for my brothers'
sake, my relatives according to the flesh
4 who are Israelites; whose is the
adoption, the glory, the covenants, the
giving of the law, the service, and the
promises;
5 of whom are the fathers, and from
whom is Christ as concerning the flesh,
who is over all, God, blessed forever.
Amen.
6 But it is not as though the word of God
has come to nothing. For they are not all
Israel that are of Israel.
7 Neither, because they are Abraham's
offspring, are they all children. But, "your
offspring will be accounted as from
Isaac."*
8 That is, it is not the children of the flesh
who are children of God, but the children
of the promise are counted as heirs.
9 For this is a word of promise: "At the
appointed time I will come, and Sarah will
have a son."*
10 Not only so, but Rebekah also
conceived by one, by our father Isaac.
11 For being not yet born, neither having
done anything good or bad, that the
purpose of God according to election
might stand, not of works, but of him who
calls,†
12 it was said to her, "The elder will
serve the younger."*
13 Even as it is written, "Jacob I loved,
but Esau I hated."*
14 What shall we say then? Is there
unrighteousness with God? May it never
be!
15 For he said to Moses, "I will have
mercy on whom I have mercy, and I will
have compassion on whom I have
compassion."*
16 So then it is not of him who wills, nor
of him who runs, but of God who has
mercy.
17 For the Scripture says to Pharaoh,
"For this very purpose I caused you to be
raised up, that I might show in you my
power, and that my name might be
proclaimed in all the earth."*
18 So then, he has mercy on whom he
desires, and he hardens whom he desires.
19 You will say then to me, "Why does he
still find fault? For who withstands his
will?"
20 But indeed, O man, who are you to
reply against God? Will the thing formed
ask him who formed it, "Why did you
make me like this?"*
21 Or hasn't the potter a right over the
clay, from the same lump to make one
part a vessel for honor, and another for
dishonor?
22 What if God, willing to show his
wrath and to make his power known,
endured with much patience vessels of
wrath prepared for destruction,
23 and that he might make known the
riches of his glory on vessels of mercy,
which he prepared beforehand for glory—
24 us, whom he also called, not from the
Jews only, but also from the Gentiles?
25 As he says also in Hosea,

"I will call them 'my people,' which were
not my people;
and her 'beloved,' who was not
beloved."*

* **9:7** Genesis 21:12 * **9:9** Genesis 18:10,14 † **9:11** NU puts the phrase "not of works, but of him who calls" at the beginning of verse 12 instead of the end of verse 11. * **9:12** Genesis 25:23 * **9:13** Malachi 1:2-3 * **9:15** Exodus 33:19 * **9:17** Exodus 9:16 * **9:20** Isaiah 29:16; 45:9 * **9:25** Hosea 2:23

26 “It will be that in the place where it was
said to them, ‘You are not my
people,’
there they will be called ‘children of
the living God.’ ”*
27 Isaiah cries concerning Israel,
“If the number of the children of Israel
are as the sand of the sea,
it is the remnant who will be saved;
28 for he will finish the work and cut it
short in righteousness,
because the Lord will make a short
work upon the earth.”*
29 As Isaiah has said before,
“Unless the Lord of Armies‡ had left us a
seed,
we would have become like Sodom,
and would have been made like
Gomorrah.”*
30 What shall we say then? That the Gentiles, who didn’t follow after righteousness, attained to righteousness, even the righteousness which is of faith;
31 but Israel, following after a law of righteousness, didn’t arrive at the law of righteousness.
32 Why? Because they didn’t seek it by faith, but as it were by works of the law. They stumbled over the stumbling stone,
33 even as it is written,
“Behold,§ I lay in Zion a stumbling stone
and a rock of offense;
and no one who believes in him will
be disappointed.”*

10

1 Brothers, my heart’s desire and my prayer to God is for Israel, that they may be saved.
2 For I testify about them that they have a zeal for God, but not according to knowledge.
3 For being ignorant of God’s righteousness, and seeking to establish their own righteousness, they didn’t subject themselves to the righteousness of God.
4 For Christ is the fulfillment† of the law for righteousness to everyone who believes.
5 For Moses writes about the righteousness of the law, “The one who does them will live by them.”*
6 But the righteousness which is of faith says this, “Don’t say in your heart, ‘Who will ascend into heaven?’* (that is, to bring Christ down);
7 or, ‘Who will descend into the abyss?’* (that is, to bring Christ up from the dead.)”
8 But what does it say? “The word is near you, in your mouth and in your heart;”* that is, the word of faith which we preach:
9 that if you will confess with your mouth that Jesus is Lord and believe in your heart that God raised him from the dead, you will be saved.
10 For with the heart one believes resulting in righteousness; and with the mouth confession is made resulting in salvation.
11 For the Scripture says, “Whoever believes in him will not be disappointed.”*
12 For there is no distinction between Jew and Greek; for the same Lord is Lord of all, and is rich to all who call on him.
13 For, “Whoever will call on the name of the Lord will be saved.”*
14 How then will they call on him in whom they have not believed? How will they believe in him whom they have not heard? How will they hear without a preacher?
15 And how will they preach unless they are sent? As it is written:
“How beautiful are the feet of those who
preach the Good News of peace,
who bring glad tidings of good
things!”*
16 But they didn’t all listen to the glad news. For Isaiah says, “Lord, who has believed our report?”*

* **9:26** Hosea 1:10 * **9:28** Isaiah 10:22-23 ‡ **9:29** Greek: Sabaoth (or Hebrew: Tze’va’ot) * **9:29** Isaiah 1:9
§ **9:33** “Behold”, from “ἰδοὺ”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
* **9:33** Isaiah 8:14; 28:16 † **10:4** or, completion, or end * **10:5** Leviticus 18:5 * **10:6** Deuteronomy 30:12
* **10:7** Deuteronomy 30:13 * **10:8** Deuteronomy 30:14 * **10:11** Isaiah 28:16 * **10:13** Joel 2:32 * **10:15** Isaiah 52:7 * **10:16** Isaiah 53:1

17 So faith comes by hearing, and
hearing by the word of God.
18 But I say, didn't they hear? Yes, most
certainly,
"Their sound went out into all the earth,
their words to the ends of the world."*
19 But I ask, didn't Israel know? First
Moses says,
"I will provoke you to jealousy with that
which is no nation.
I will make you angry with a nation
void of understanding."*
20 Isaiah is very bold and says,
"I was found by those who didn't seek me.
I was revealed to those who didn't ask
for me."*
21 But about Israel he says, "All day long
I stretched out my hands to a disobedient
and contrary people."*

11

1 I ask then, did God reject his people?
May it never be! For I also am an Israelite,
a descendant of Abraham, of the tribe of
Benjamin.
2 God didn't reject his people, whom he
foreknew. Or don't you know what the
Scripture says about Elijah? How he
pleads with God against Israel:
3 "Lord, they have killed your prophets.
They have broken down your altars. I am
left alone, and they seek my life."*
4 But how does God answer him? "I have
reserved for myself seven thousand men
who have not bowed the knee to Baal."*
5 Even so too at this present time also
there is a remnant according to the
election of grace.
6 And if by grace, then it is no longer of
works; otherwise grace is no longer grace.
But if it is of works, it is no longer grace;
otherwise work is no longer work.
7 What then? That which Israel seeks
for, that he didn't obtain, but the chosen
ones obtained it, and the rest were
hardened.
8 According as it is written, "God gave
them a spirit of stupor, eyes that they
should not see, and ears that they should
not hear, to this very day."*
9 David says,
"Let their table be made a snare, a trap,
a stumbling block, and a retribution
to them.
10 Let their eyes be darkened, that they
may not see.
Always keep their backs bent."*
11 I ask then, did they stumble that they
might fall? May it never be! But by their
fall salvation has come to the Gentiles, to
provoke them to jealousy.
12 Now if their fall is the riches of the
world, and their loss the riches of the
Gentiles, how much more their fullness!
13 For I speak to you who are Gentiles.
Since then as I am an apostle to Gentiles, I
glorify my ministry,
14 if by any means I may provoke to
jealousy those who are my flesh, and may
save some of them.
15 For if the rejection of them is the
reconciling of the world, what would their
acceptance be, but life from the dead?
16 If the first fruit is holy, so is the lump.
If the root is holy, so are the branches.
17 But if some of the branches were
broken off, and you, being a wild olive,
were grafted in among them and became
partaker with them of the root and of the
richness of the olive tree,
18 don't boast over the branches. But if
you boast, remember that it is not you
who support the root, but the root
supports you.
19 You will say then, "Branches were
broken off, that I might be grafted in."
20 True; by their unbelief they were
broken off, and you stand by your faith.
Don't be conceited, but fear;
21 for if God didn't spare the natural
branches, neither will he spare you.
22 See then the goodness and severity of
God. Toward those who fell, severity; but
toward you, goodness, if you continue in
his goodness; otherwise you also will be
cut off.

* **10:18** Psalms 19:4 * **10:19** Deuteronomy 32:21 * **10:20** Isaiah 65:1 * **10:21** Isaiah 65:2 * **11:3** 1 Kings 19:10,14 * **11:4** 1 Kings 19:18 * **11:8** Deuteronomy 29:4; Isaiah 29:10 * **11:10** Psalms 69:22,23

23 They also, if they don't continue in
their unbelief, will be grafted in, for God
is able to graft them in again.
24 For if you were cut out of that which
is by nature a wild olive tree, and were
grafted contrary to nature into a good
olive tree, how much more will these,
which are the natural branches, be
grafted into their own olive tree?
25 For I don't desire you to be ignorant,
brothers,† of this mystery, so that you
won't be wise in your own conceits, that a
partial hardening has happened to Israel,
until the fullness of the Gentiles has come
in,
26 and so all Israel will be saved. Even as
it is written,
"There will come out of Zion the Deliverer,
and he will turn away ungodliness
from Jacob.
27 This is my covenant with them,
when I will take away their sins."*
28 Concerning the Good News, they are
enemies for your sake. But concerning the
election, they are beloved for the fathers'
sake.
29 For the gifts and the calling of God are
irrevocable.
30 For as you in time past were
disobedient to God, but now have
obtained mercy by their disobedience,
31 even so these also have now been
disobedient, that by the mercy shown to
you they may also obtain mercy.
32 For God has bound all to
disobedience, that he might have mercy
on all.
33 Oh the depth of the riches both of the
wisdom and the knowledge of God! How
unsearchable are his judgments, and his
ways past tracing out!
34 "For who has known the mind of the
Lord?
Or who has been his counselor?"*
35 "Or who has first given to him,
and it will be repaid to him again?"*
36 For of him and through him and to
him are all things. To him be the glory for
ever! Amen.

12

1 Therefore I urge you, brothers, by the
mercies of God, to present your bodies a
living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God,
which is your spiritual service.
2 Don't be conformed to this world, but
be transformed by the renewing of your
mind, so that you may prove what is the
good, well-pleasing, and perfect will of
God.
3 For I say through the grace that was
given me, to everyone who is among you,
not to think of yourself more highly than
you ought to think; but to think
reasonably, as God has apportioned to
each person a measure of faith.
4 For even as we have many members in
one body, and all the members don't have
the same function,
5 so we, who are many, are one body in
Christ, and individually members of one
another,
6 having gifts differing according to the
grace that was given to us: if prophecy,
let's prophesy according to the proportion
of our faith;
7 or service, let's give ourselves to
service; or he who teaches, to his teaching;
8 or he who exhorts, to his exhorting; he
who gives, let him do it with generosity;
he who rules, with diligence; he who
shows mercy, with cheerfulness.
9 Let love be without hypocrisy. Abhor
that which is evil. Cling to that which is
good.
10 In love of the brothers be tenderly
affectionate to one another; in honor
prefer one another,
11 not lagging in diligence, fervent in
spirit, serving the Lord,
12 rejoicing in hope, enduring in
troubles, continuing steadfastly in prayer,
13 contributing to the needs of the
saints, and given to hospitality.
14 Bless those who persecute you; bless,
and don't curse.
15 Rejoice with those who rejoice. Weep
with those who weep.

† **11:25** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **11:27** Isaiah 59:20-21; 27:9; Jeremiah 31:33-34 * **11:34** Isaiah 40:13 * **11:35** Job 41:11

16 Be of the same mind one toward
another. Don't set your mind on high
things, but associate with the humble.
Don't be wise in your own conceits.
17 Repay no one evil for evil. Respect
what is honorable in the sight of all men.
18 If it is possible, as much as it is up to
you, be at peace with all men.
19 Don't seek revenge yourselves,
beloved, but give place to God's wrath. For
it is written, "Vengeance belongs to me; I
will repay, says the Lord."*
20 Therefore
"If your enemy is hungry, feed him.
If he is thirsty, give him a drink;
for in doing so, you will heap coals of
fire on his head."*
21 Don't be overcome by evil, but
overcome evil with good.

13

1 Let every soul be in subjection to the
higher authorities, for there is no
authority except from God, and those who
exist are ordained by God.
2 Therefore he who resists the authority
withstands the ordinance of God; and
those who withstand will receive to
themselves judgment.
3 For rulers are not a terror to the good
work, but to the evil. Do you desire to
have no fear of the authority? Do that
which is good, and you will have praise
from the authority,
4 for he is a servant of God to you for
good. But if you do that which is evil, be
afraid, for he doesn't bear the sword in
vain; for he is a servant of God, an
avenger for wrath to him who does evil.
5 Therefore you need to be in
subjection, not only because of the wrath,
but also for conscience' sake.
6 For this reason you also pay taxes, for
they are servants of God's service,
continually doing this very thing.
7 Therefore give everyone what you
owe: if you owe taxes, pay taxes; if
customs, then customs; if respect, then
respect; if honor, then honor.
8 Owe no one anything, except to love
one another; for he who loves his
neighbor has fulfilled the law.
9 For the commandments, "You shall not
commit adultery," "You shall not murder,"
"You shall not steal,"† "You shall not
covet,"* and whatever other
commandments there are, are all
summed up in this saying, namely, "You
shall love your neighbor as yourself."*
10 Love doesn't harm a neighbor. Love
therefore is the fulfillment of the law.
11 Do this, knowing the time, that it is
already time for you to awaken out of
sleep, for salvation is now nearer to us
than when we first believed.
12 The night is far gone, and the day is
near. Let's therefore throw off the deeds
of darkness, and let's put on the armor of
light.
13 Let's walk properly, as in the day; not
in reveling and drunkenness, not in
sexual promiscuity and lustful acts, and
not in strife and jealousy.
14 But put on the Lord Jesus Christ, and
make no provision for the flesh, for its
lusts.

14

1 Now accept one who is weak in faith,
but not for disputes over opinions.
2 One man has faith to eat all things, but
he who is weak eats only vegetables.
3 Don't let him who eats despise him
who doesn't eat. Don't let him who doesn't
eat judge him who eats, for God has
accepted him.
4 Who are you who judge another's
servant? To his own lord he stands or
falls. Yes, he will be made to stand, for
God has power to make him stand.
5 One man esteems one day as more
important. Another esteems every day
alike. Let each man be fully assured in his
own mind.
6 He who observes the day, observes it
to the Lord; and he who does not observe
the day, to the Lord he does not observe it.
He who eats, eats to the Lord, for he gives

* **12:19** Deuteronomy 32:35 * **12:20** Proverbs 25:21-22 † **13:9** TR adds "You shall not give false testimony,"
* **13:9** Exodus 20:13-15,17; Deuteronomy 5:17-19,21 * **13:9** Leviticus 19:18

God thanks. He who doesn't eat, to the
Lord he doesn't eat, and gives God thanks.
7 For none of us lives to himself, and
none dies to himself.
8 For if we live, we live to the Lord. Or if
we die, we die to the Lord. If therefore we
live or die, we are the Lord's.
9 For to this end Christ died, rose, and
lived again, that he might be Lord of both
the dead and the living.

10 But you, why do you judge your
brother? Or you again, why do you
despise your brother? For we will all
stand before the judgment seat of Christ.
11 For it is written,

" 'As I live,' says the Lord, 'to me every
knee will bow.
Every tongue will confess to God.' "*

12 So then each one of us will give
account of himself to God.

13 Therefore let's not judge one another
any more, but judge this rather, that no
man put a stumbling block in his brother's
way, or an occasion for falling.
14 I know and am persuaded in the Lord
Jesus that nothing is unclean of itself;
except that to him who considers
anything to be unclean, to him it is
unclean.
15 Yet if because of food your brother is
grieved, you walk no longer in love. Don't
destroy with your food him for whom
Christ died.
16 Then don't let your good be
slandered,
17 for God's Kingdom is not eating and
drinking, but righteousness, peace, and
joy in the Holy Spirit.
18 For he who serves Christ in these
things is acceptable to God and approved
by men.
19 So then, let's follow after things which
make for peace, and things by which we
may build one another up.
20 Don't overthrow God's work for
food's sake. All things indeed are clean,
however it is evil for that man who
creates a stumbling block by eating.
21 It is good to not eat meat, drink wine,
nor do anything by which your brother
stumbles, is offended, or is made weak.
22 Do you have faith? Have it to yourself
before God. Happy is he who doesn't
judge himself in that which he approves.
23 But he who doubts is condemned if he
eats, because it isn't of faith; and
whatever is not of faith is sin.
24 Now to him who is able to establish
you according to my Good News and the
preaching of Jesus Christ, according to the
revelation of the mystery which has been
kept secret through long ages,
25 but now is revealed, and by the
Scriptures of the prophets, according to
the commandment of the eternal God, is
made known for obedience of faith to all
the nations;
26 to the only wise God, through Jesus
Christ, to whom be the glory forever!
Amen.†

15

1 Now we who are strong ought to bear
the weaknesses of the weak, and not to
please ourselves.
2 Let each one of us please his neighbor
for that which is good, to be building him
up.
3 For even Christ didn't please himself.
But, as it is written, "The reproaches of
those who reproached you fell on me."*
4 For whatever things were written
before were written for our learning, that
through perseverance and through
encouragement of the Scriptures we
might have hope.
5 Now the God of perseverance and of
encouragement grant you to be of the
same mind with one another according to
Christ Jesus,
6 that with one accord you may with one
mouth glorify the God and Father of our
Lord Jesus Christ.
7 Therefore accept one another, even as
Christ also accepted you,† to the glory of
God.
8 Now I say that Christ has been made a
servant of the circumcision for the truth

* **14:11** Isaiah 45:23 † **14:26** TR places verses 24-26 after Romans 16:24 as verses 25-27. * **15:3** Psalms 69:9
† **15:7** TR reads "us" instead of "you"

of God, that he might confirm the
promises given to the fathers,
9 and that the Gentiles might glorify God
for his mercy. As it is written,
"Therefore I will give praise to you among
the Gentiles
and sing to your name."*
10 Again he says,
"Rejoice, you Gentiles, with his people."*
11 Again,
"Praise the Lord, all you Gentiles!
Let all the peoples praise him."*
12 Again, Isaiah says,
"There will be the root of Jesse,
he who arises to rule over the
Gentiles;
in him the Gentiles will hope."*
13 Now may the God of hope fill you
with all joy and peace in believing, that
you may abound in hope in the power of
the Holy Spirit.
14 I myself am also persuaded about
you, my brothers,‡ that you yourselves are
full of goodness, filled with all knowledge,
able also to admonish others.
15 But I write the more boldly to you in
part as reminding you, because of the
grace that was given to me by God,
16 that I should be a servant of Christ
Jesus to the Gentiles, serving as a priest of
the Good News of God, that the offering
up of the Gentiles might be made
acceptable, sanctified by the Holy Spirit.
17 I have therefore my boasting in Christ
Jesus in things pertaining to God.
18 For I will not dare to speak of any
things except those which Christ worked
through me for the obedience of the
Gentiles, by word and deed,
19 in the power of signs and wonders, in
the power of God's Spirit; so that from
Jerusalem and around as far as to
Illyricum, I have fully preached the Good
News of Christ;
20 yes, making it my aim to preach the
Good News, not where Christ was already
named, that I might not build on another's
foundation.
21 But, as it is written,
"They will see, to whom no news of him
came.
They who haven't heard will
understand."*
22 Therefore also I was hindered these
many times from coming to you,
23 but now, no longer having any place
in these regions, and having these many
years a longing to come to you,
24 whenever I travel to Spain, I will
come to you. For I hope to see you on my
journey, and to be helped on my way
there by you, if first I may enjoy your
company for a while.
25 But now, I say, I am going to
Jerusalem, serving the saints.
26 For it has been the good pleasure of
Macedonia and Achaia to make a certain
contribution for the poor among the
saints who are at Jerusalem.
27 Yes, it has been their good pleasure,
and they are their debtors. For if the
Gentiles have been made partakers of
their spiritual things, they owe it to them
also to serve them in material things.
28 When therefore I have accomplished
this, and have sealed to them this fruit, I
will go on by way of you to Spain.
29 I know that when I come to you, I will
come in the fullness of the blessing of the
Good News of Christ.
30 Now I beg you, brothers, by our Lord
Jesus Christ and by the love of the Spirit,
that you strive together with me in your
prayers to God for me,
31 that I may be delivered from those
who are disobedient in Judea, and that my
service which I have for Jerusalem may
be acceptable to the saints,
32 that I may come to you in joy through
the will of God, and together with you,
find rest.
33 Now the God of peace be with you all.
Amen.

* **15:9** 2 Samuel 22:50; Psalms 18:49 * **15:10** Deuteronomy 32:43 * **15:11** Psalms 117:1 * **15:12** Isaiah 11:10 ‡ **15:14** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **15:21** Isaiah 52:15 † **16:1** or, deacon

16

1 I commend to you Phoebe, our sister,
who is a servant† of the assembly that is at
Cenchreae,
2 that you receive her in the Lord in a
way worthy of the saints, and that you
assist her in whatever matter she may
need from you, for she herself also has
been a helper of many, and of my own
self.
3 Greet Prisca and Aquila, my fellow
workers in Christ Jesus,
4 who risked their own necks for my life,
to whom not only I give thanks, but also
all the assemblies of the Gentiles.
5 Greet the assembly that is in their
house. Greet Epaenetus, my beloved, who
is the first fruits of Achaia to Christ.
6 Greet Mary, who labored much for us.
7 Greet Andronicus and Junia, my
relatives and my fellow prisoners, who
are notable among the apostles, who were
also in Christ before me.
8 Greet Amplias, my beloved in the Lord.
9 Greet Urbanus, our fellow worker in
Christ, and Stachys, my beloved.
10 Greet Apelles, the approved in Christ.
Greet those who are of the household of
Aristobulus.
11 Greet Herodion, my kinsman. Greet
them of the household of Narcissus, who
are in the Lord.
12 Greet Tryphaena and Tryphosa, who
labor in the Lord. Greet Persis, the
beloved, who labored much in the Lord.
13 Greet Rufus, the chosen in the Lord,
and his mother and mine.
14 Greet Asyncritus, Phlegon, Hermes,
Patrobas, Hermas, and the brothers‡ who
are with them.
15 Greet Philologus and Julia, Nereus
and his sister, and Olympas, and all the
saints who are with them.
16 Greet one another with a holy kiss.
The assemblies of Christ greet you.
17 Now I beg you, brothers, look out for
those who are causing the divisions and
occasions of stumbling, contrary to the
doctrine which you learned, and turn
away from them.
18 For those who are such don't serve
our Lord Jesus Christ, but their own belly;
and by their smooth and flattering speech
they deceive the hearts of the innocent.
19 For your obedience has become
known to all. I rejoice therefore over you.
But I desire to have you wise in that which
is good, but innocent in that which is evil.
20 And the God of peace will quickly
crush Satan under your feet.
The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be
with you.
21 Timothy, my fellow worker, greets
you, as do Lucius, Jason, and Sosipater,
my relatives.
22 I, Tertius, who write the letter, greet
you in the Lord.
23 Gaius, my host and host of the whole
assembly, greets you. Erastus, the
treasurer of the city, greets you, as does
Quartus, the brother.
24 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be
with you all! Amen.
25 §

‡ **16:14** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." § **16:25** TR places Romans 14:24-26 at the end of Romans instead of at the end of chapter 14, and numbers these verses 16:25-27.

Paul's First Letter to the Corinthians

1 Paul, called to be an apostle of Jesus Christ† through the will of God, and our brother Sosthenes,
2 to the assembly of God which is at Corinth—those who are sanctified in Christ Jesus, called saints, with all who call on the name of our Lord Jesus Christ in every place, both theirs and ours:
3 Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.
4 I always thank my God concerning you for the grace of God which was given you in Christ Jesus,
5 that in everything you were enriched in him, in all speech and all knowledge—
6 even as the testimony of Christ was confirmed in you—
7 so that you come behind in no gift, waiting for the revelation of our Lord Jesus Christ,
8 who will also confirm you until the end, blameless in the day of our Lord Jesus Christ.
9 God is faithful, through whom you were called into the fellowship of his Son, Jesus Christ our Lord.
10 Now I beg you, brothers,‡ through the name of our Lord, Jesus Christ, that you all speak the same thing, and that there be no divisions among you, but that you be perfected together in the same mind and in the same judgment.
11 For it has been reported to me concerning you, my brothers, by those who are from Chloe's household, that there are contentions among you.
12 Now I mean this, that each one of you says, "I follow Paul," "I follow Apollos," "I follow Cephas," and, "I follow Christ."
13 Is Christ divided? Was Paul crucified for you? Or were you baptized into the name of Paul?
14 I thank God that I baptized none of you except Crispus and Gaius,
15 so that no one should say that I had baptized you into my own name.
16 (I also baptized the household of Stephanas; besides them, I don't know whether I baptized any other.)
17 For Christ sent me not to baptize, but to preach the Good News—not in wisdom of words, so that the cross of Christ wouldn't be made void.
18 For the word of the cross is foolishness to those who are dying, but to us who are being saved it is the power of God.
19 For it is written,

"I will destroy the wisdom of the wise.
I will bring the discernment of the discerning to nothing."*

20 Where is the wise? Where is the scribe? Where is the debater of this age? Hasn't God made foolish the wisdom of this world?
21 For seeing that in the wisdom of God, the world through its wisdom didn't know God, it was God's good pleasure through the foolishness of the preaching to save those who believe.
22 For Jews ask for signs, Greeks seek after wisdom,
23 but we preach Christ crucified, a stumbling block to Jews and foolishness to Greeks,
24 but to those who are called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ is the power of God and the wisdom of God;
25 because the foolishness of God is wiser than men, and the weakness of God is stronger than men.
26 For you see your calling, brothers, that not many are wise according to the flesh, not many mighty, and not many noble;
27 but God chose the foolish things of the world that he might put to shame those who are wise. God chose the weak things of the world that he might put to shame the things that are strong.
28 God chose the lowly things of the world, and the things that are despised, and the things that don't exist, that he

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:10** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **1:19** Isaiah 29:14

might bring to nothing the things that exist,
29 that no flesh should boast before God.
30 Because of him, you are in Christ Jesus, who was made to us wisdom from God, and righteousness and sanctification, and redemption,
31 that, as it is written, “He who boasts, let him boast in the Lord.”*

2

1 When I came to you, brothers, I didn’t come with excellence of speech or of wisdom, proclaiming to you the testimony of God.
2 For I determined not to know anything among you except Jesus Christ and him crucified.
3 I was with you in weakness, in fear, and in much trembling.
4 My speech and my preaching were not in persuasive words of human wisdom, but in demonstration of the Spirit and of power,
5 that your faith wouldn’t stand in the wisdom of men, but in the power of God.
6 We speak wisdom, however, among those who are full grown, yet a wisdom not of this world nor of the rulers of this world who are coming to nothing.
7 But we speak God’s wisdom in a mystery, the wisdom that has been hidden, which God foreordained before the worlds for our glory,
8 which none of the rulers of this world has known. For had they known it, they wouldn’t have crucified the Lord of glory.
9 But as it is written,
“Things which an eye didn’t see, and an ear didn’t hear,
which didn’t enter into the heart of man,
these God has prepared for those who love him.”*
10 But to us, God revealed them through the Spirit. For the Spirit searches all things, yes, the deep things of God.
11 For who among men knows the things of a man except the spirit of the man which is in him? Even so, no one knows the things of God except God’s Spirit.
12 But we received not the spirit of the world, but the Spirit which is from God, that we might know the things that were freely given to us by God.
13 We also speak these things, not in words which man’s wisdom teaches but which the Holy Spirit teaches, comparing spiritual things with spiritual things.
14 Now the natural man doesn’t receive the things of God’s Spirit, for they are foolishness to him; and he can’t know them, because they are spiritually discerned.
15 But he who is spiritual discerns all things, and he himself is to be judged by no one.
16 “For who has known the mind of the Lord that he should instruct him?”* But we have Christ’s mind.

3

1 Brothers, I couldn’t speak to you as to spiritual, but as to fleshly, as to babies in Christ.
2 I fed you with milk, not with solid food, for you weren’t yet ready. Indeed, you aren’t ready even now,
3 for you are still fleshly. For insofar as there is jealousy, strife, and factions among you, aren’t you fleshly, and don’t you walk in the ways of men?
4 For when one says, “I follow Paul,” and another, “I follow Apollos,” aren’t you fleshly?
5 Who then is Apollos, and who is Paul, but servants through whom you believed, and each as the Lord gave to him?
6 I planted. Apollos watered. But God gave the increase.
7 So then neither he who plants is anything, nor he who waters, but God who gives the increase.
8 Now he who plants and he who waters are the same, but each will receive his own reward according to his own labor.
9 For we are God’s fellow workers. You are God’s farming, God’s building.
10 According to the grace of God which was given to me, as a wise master builder I laid a foundation, and another builds on

* **1:31** Jeremiah 9:24 * **2:9** Isaiah 64:4 * **2:16** Isaiah 40:13

it. But let each man be careful how he
builds on it.
11 For no one can lay any other
foundation than that which has been laid,
which is Jesus Christ.
12 But if anyone builds on the
foundation with gold, silver, costly stones,
wood, hay, or straw,
13 each man's work will be revealed. For
the Day will declare it, because it is
revealed in fire; and the fire itself will test
what sort of work each man's work is.
14 If any man's work remains which he
built on it, he will receive a reward.
15 If any man's work is burned, he will
suffer loss, but he himself will be saved,
but as through fire.
16 Don't you know that you are God's
temple and that God's Spirit lives in you?
17 If anyone destroys God's temple, God
will destroy him; for God's temple is holy,
which you are.
18 Let no one deceive himself. If anyone
thinks that he is wise among you in this
world, let him become a fool that he may
become wise.
19 For the wisdom of this world is
foolishness with God. For it is written, "He
has taken the wise in their craftiness."*
20 And again, "The Lord knows the
reasoning of the wise, that it is
worthless."*
21 Therefore let no one boast in men.
For all things are yours,
22 whether Paul, or Apollos, or Cephas,
or the world, or life, or death, or things
present, or things to come. All are yours,
23 and you are Christ's, and Christ is
God's.

4

1 So let a man think of us as Christ's
servants and stewards of God's mysteries.
2 Here, moreover, it is required of
stewards that they be found faithful.
3 But with me it is a very small thing that
I should be judged by you, or by a human
court. Yes, I don't even judge my own self.
4 For I know nothing against myself. Yet
I am not justified by this, but he who
judges me is the Lord.
5 Therefore judge nothing before the
time, until the Lord comes, who will both
bring to light the hidden things of
darkness and reveal the counsels of the
hearts. Then each man will get his praise
from God.
6 Now these things, brothers, I have in a
figure transferred to myself and Apollos
for your sakes, that in us you might learn
not to think beyond the things which are
written, that none of you be puffed up
against one another.
7 For who makes you different? And
what do you have that you didn't receive?
But if you did receive it, why do you boast
as if you had not received it?
8 You are already filled. You have
already become rich. You have come to
reign without us. Yes, and I wish that you
did reign, that we also might reign with
you!
9 For I think that God has displayed us,
the apostles, last of all, like men sentenced
to death. For we are made a spectacle to
the world, both to angels and men.
10 We are fools for Christ's sake, but you
are wise in Christ. We are weak, but you
are strong. You have honor, but we have
dishonor.
11 Even to this present hour we hunger,
thirst, are naked, are beaten, and have no
certain dwelling place.
12 We toil, working with our own hands.
When people curse us, we bless. Being
persecuted, we endure.
13 Being defamed, we entreat. We are
made as the filth of the world, the dirt
wiped off by all, even until now.
14 I don't write these things to shame
you, but to admonish you as my beloved
children.
15 For though you have ten thousand
tutors in Christ, you don't have many
fathers. For in Christ Jesus, I became your
father through the Good News.
16 I beg you therefore, be imitators of
me.
17 Because of this I have sent Timothy to
you, who is my beloved and faithful child
in the Lord, who will remind you of my

* **3:19** Job 5:13 * **3:20** Psalms 94:11

ways which are in Christ, even as I teach everywhere in every assembly.
18 Now some are puffed up, as though I were not coming to you.
19 But I will come to you shortly, if the Lord is willing. And I will know, not the word of those who are puffed up, but the power.
20 For God's Kingdom is not in word, but in power.
21 What do you want? Shall I come to you with a rod, or in love and a spirit of gentleness?

5

1 It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality among you, and such sexual immorality as is not even named among the Gentiles, that one has his father's wife.
2 You are arrogant, and didn't mourn instead, that he who had done this deed might be removed from among you.
3 For I most certainly, as being absent in body but present in spirit, have already, as though I were present, judged him who has done this thing.
4 In the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, when you are gathered together with my spirit with the power of our Lord Jesus Christ,
5 you are to deliver such a one to Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that the spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord Jesus.
6 Your boasting is not good. Don't you know that a little yeast leavens the whole lump?
7 Purge out the old yeast, that you may be a new lump, even as you are unleavened. For indeed Christ, our Passover, has been sacrificed in our place.
8 Therefore let's keep the feast, not with old yeast, neither with the yeast of malice and wickedness, but with the unleavened bread of sincerity and truth.
9 I wrote to you in my letter to have no company with sexual sinners;
10 yet not at all meaning with the sexual sinners of this world, or with the covetous and extortionists, or with idolaters, for then you would have to leave the world.
11 But as it is, I wrote to you not to associate with anyone who is called a brother who is a sexual sinner, or covetous, or an idolater, or a slanderer, or a drunkard, or an extortionist. Don't even eat with such a person.
12 For what do I have to do with also judging those who are outside? Don't you judge those who are within?
13 But those who are outside, God judges. "Put away the wicked man from among yourselves."*

6

1 Dare any of you, having a matter against his neighbor, go to law before the unrighteous, and not before the saints?
2 Don't you know that the saints will judge the world? And if the world is judged by you, are you unworthy to judge the smallest matters?
3 Don't you know that we will judge angels? How much more, things that pertain to this life?
4 If then you have to judge things pertaining to this life, do you set them to judge who are of no account in the assembly?
5 I say this to move you to shame. Isn't there even one wise man among you who would be able to decide between his brothers?
6 But brother goes to law with brother, and that before unbelievers!
7 Therefore it is already altogether a defect in you that you have lawsuits one with another. Why not rather be wronged? Why not rather be defrauded?
8 No, but you yourselves do wrong and defraud, and that against your brothers.

9 Or don't you know that the unrighteous will not inherit God's Kingdom? Don't be deceived. Neither the sexually immoral, nor idolaters, nor adulterers, nor male prostitutes, nor homosexuals,

* **5:13** Deuteronomy 17:7; 19:19; 21:21; 22:21; 24:7

10 nor thieves, nor covetous, nor
drunkards, nor slanderers, nor
extortionists, will inherit God's Kingdom.
11 Some of you were such, but you were
washed. You were sanctified. You were
justified in the name of the Lord Jesus,
and in the Spirit of our God.
12 "All things are lawful for me," but not
all things are expedient. "All things are
lawful for me," but I will not be brought
under the power of anything.
13 "Foods for the belly, and the belly for
foods," but God will bring to nothing both
it and them. But the body is not for sexual
immorality, but for the Lord, and the Lord
for the body.
14 Now God raised up the Lord, and will
also raise us up by his power.
15 Don't you know that your bodies are
members of Christ? Shall I then take the
members of Christ and make them
members of a prostitute? May it never be!
16 Or don't you know that he who is
joined to a prostitute is one body? For,
"The two", he says, "will become one
flesh."*
17 But he who is joined to the Lord is one
spirit.
18 Flee sexual immorality! "Every sin
that a man does is outside the body," but
he who commits sexual immorality sins
against his own body.
19 Or don't you know that your body is a
temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you,
whom you have from God? You are not
your own,
20 for you were bought with a price.
Therefore glorify God in your body and in
your spirit, which are God's.

7

1 Now concerning the things about
which you wrote to me: it is good for a
man not to touch a woman.
2 But, because of sexual immoralities,
let each man have his own wife, and let
each woman have her own husband.
3 Let the husband give his wife the
affection owed her,† and likewise also the
wife her husband.
4 The wife doesn't have authority over
her own body, but the husband does.
Likewise also the husband doesn't have
authority over his own body, but the wife
does.
5 Don't deprive one another, unless it is
by consent for a season, that you may give
yourselves to fasting and prayer, and may
be together again, that Satan doesn't
tempt you because of your lack of
self-control.
6 But this I say by way of concession, not
of commandment.
7 Yet I wish that all men were like me.
However, each man has his own gift from
God, one of this kind, and another of that
kind.
8 But I say to the unmarried and to
widows, it is good for them if they remain
even as I am.
9 But if they don't have self-control, let
them marry. For it's better to marry than
to burn with passion.
10 But to the married I command—not I,
but the Lord—that the wife not leave her
husband
11 (but if she departs, let her remain
unmarried, or else be reconciled to her
husband), and that the husband not leave
his wife.
12 But to the rest I—not the Lord—say, if
any brother has an unbelieving wife, and
she is content to live with him, let him not
leave her.
13 The woman who has an unbelieving
husband, and he is content to live with
her, let her not leave her husband.
14 For the unbelieving husband is
sanctified in the wife, and the unbelieving
wife is sanctified in the husband.
Otherwise your children would be
unclean, but now they are holy.
15 Yet if the unbeliever departs, let there
be separation. The brother or the sister is
not under bondage in such cases, but God
has called us in peace.
16 For how do you know, wife, whether
you will save your husband? Or how do
you know, husband, whether you will
save your wife?

* **6:16** Genesis 2:24 † **7:3** NU and TR have "what is owed her" instead of "the affection owed her".

17 Only, as the Lord has distributed to each man, as God has called each, so let him walk. So I command in all the assemblies.
18 Was anyone called having been circumcised? Let him not become uncircumcised. Has anyone been called in uncircumcision? Let him not be circumcised.
19 Circumcision is nothing, and uncircumcision is nothing, but what matters is keeping God's commandments.
20 Let each man stay in that calling in which he was called.
21 Were you called being a bondservant? Don't let that bother you, but if you get an opportunity to become free, use it.
22 For he who was called in the Lord being a bondservant is the Lord's free man. Likewise he who was called being free is Christ's bondservant.
23 You were bought with a price. Don't become bondservants of men.
24 Brothers, let each man, in whatever condition he was called, stay in that condition with God.
25 Now concerning virgins, I have no commandment from the Lord, but I give my judgment as one who has obtained mercy from the Lord to be trustworthy.
26 Therefore I think that because of the distress that is on us, it's good for a man to remain as he is.
27 Are you bound to a wife? Don't seek to be freed. Are you free from a wife? Don't seek a wife.
28 But if you marry, you have not sinned. If a virgin marries, she has not sinned. Yet such will have oppression in the flesh, and I want to spare you.
29 But I say this, brothers: the time is short. From now on, both those who have wives may be as though they had none;
30 and those who weep, as though they didn't weep; and those who rejoice, as though they didn't rejoice; and those who buy, as though they didn't possess;
31 and those who use the world, as not using it to the fullest. For the mode of this world passes away.
32 But I desire to have you to be free from cares. He who is unmarried is concerned for the things of the Lord, how he may please the Lord;
33 but he who is married is concerned about the things of the world, how he may please his wife.
34 There is also a difference between a wife and a virgin. The unmarried woman cares about the things of the Lord, that she may be holy both in body and in spirit. But she who is married cares about the things of the world—how she may please her husband.
35 This I say for your own benefit, not that I may ensnare you, but for that which is appropriate, and that you may attend to the Lord without distraction.
36 But if any man thinks that he is behaving inappropriately toward his virgin, if she is past the flower of her age, and if need so requires, let him do what he desires. He doesn't sin. Let them marry.
37 But he who stands steadfast in his heart, having no urgency, but has power over his own will, and has determined in his own heart to keep his own virgin, does well.
38 So then both he who gives his own virgin in marriage does well, and he who doesn't give her in marriage does better.
39 A wife is bound by law for as long as her husband lives; but if the husband is dead, she is free to be married to whomever she desires, only in the Lord.
40 But she is happier if she stays as she is, in my judgment, and I think that I also have God's Spirit.

8

1 Now concerning things sacrificed to idols: We know that we all have knowledge. Knowledge puffs up, but love builds up.
2 But if anyone thinks that he knows anything, he doesn't yet know as he ought to know.
3 But anyone who loves God is known by him.
4 Therefore concerning the eating of things sacrificed to idols, we know that no idol is anything in the world, and that there is no other God but one.
5 For though there are things that are called "gods", whether in the heavens or

on earth—as there are many “gods” and many “lords”—
6 yet to us there is one God, the Father, of whom are all things, and we for him; and one Lord, Jesus Christ, through whom are all things, and we live through him.
7 However, that knowledge isn’t in all men. But some, with consciousness of an idol until now, eat as of a thing sacrificed to an idol, and their conscience, being weak, is defiled.
8 But food will not commend us to God. For neither, if we don’t eat are we the worse, nor if we eat are we the better.
9 But be careful that by no means does this liberty of yours become a stumbling block to the weak.
10 For if a man sees you who have knowledge sitting in an idol’s temple, won’t his conscience, if he is weak, be emboldened to eat things sacrificed to idols?
11 And through your knowledge, he who is weak perishes, the brother for whose sake Christ died.
12 Thus, sinning against the brothers, and wounding their conscience when it is weak, you sin against Christ.
13 Therefore, if food causes my brother to stumble, I will eat no meat forever more, that I don’t cause my brother to stumble.

9

1 Am I not free? Am I not an apostle? Haven’t I seen Jesus Christ, our Lord? Aren’t you my work in the Lord?
2 If to others I am not an apostle, yet at least I am to you; for you are the seal of my apostleship in the Lord.
3 My defense to those who examine me is this:
4 Have we no right to eat and to drink?
5 Have we no right to take along a wife who is a believer, even as the rest of the apostles, and the brothers of the Lord, and Cephas?
6 Or have only Barnabas and I no right to not work?
7 What soldier ever serves at his own expense? Who plants a vineyard, and doesn’t eat of its fruit? Or who feeds a flock, and doesn’t drink from the flock’s milk?
8 Do I speak these things according to the ways of men? Or doesn’t the law also say the same thing?
9 For it is written in the law of Moses, “You shall not muzzle an ox while it treads out the grain.”* Is it for the oxen that God cares,
10 or does he say it assuredly for our sake? Yes, it was written for our sake, because he who plows ought to plow in hope, and he who threshes in hope should partake of his hope.
11 If we sowed to you spiritual things, is it a great thing if we reap your fleshly things?
12 If others partake of this right over you, don’t we yet more?

Nevertheless we didn’t use this right, but we bear all things, that we may cause no hindrance to the Good News of Christ.
13 Don’t you know that those who serve around sacred things eat from the things of the temple, and those who wait on the altar have their portion with the altar?
14 Even so the Lord ordained that those who proclaim the Good News should live from the Good News.
15 But I have used none of these things, and I don’t write these things that it may be done so in my case; for I would rather die, than that anyone should make my boasting void.
16 For if I preach the Good News, I have nothing to boast about, for necessity is laid on me; but woe is to me if I don’t preach the Good News.
17 For if I do this of my own will, I have a reward. But if not of my own will, I have a stewardship entrusted to me.
18 What then is my reward? That when I preach the Good News, I may present the Good News of Christ without charge, so as not to abuse my authority in the Good News.
19 For though I was free from all, I brought myself under bondage to all, that I might gain the more.

* **9:9** Deuteronomy 25:4

20 To the Jews I became as a Jew, that I might gain Jews; to those who are under the law, as under the law,† that I might gain those who are under the law;
21 to those who are without law, as without law (not being without law toward God, but under law toward Christ), that I might win those who are without law.
22 To the weak I became as weak, that I might gain the weak. I have become all things to all men, that I may by all means save some.
23 Now I do this for the sake of the Good News, that I may be a joint partaker of it.
24 Don't you know that those who run in a race all run, but one receives the prize? Run like that, so that you may win.
25 Every man who strives in the games exercises self-control in all things. Now they do it to receive a corruptible crown, but we an incorruptible.
26 I therefore run like that, not aimlessly. I fight like that, not beating the air,
27 but I beat my body and bring it into submission, lest by any means, after I have preached to others, I myself should be disqualified.

10

1 Now I would not have you ignorant, brothers, that our fathers were all under the cloud, and all passed through the sea;
2 and were all baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the sea;
3 and all ate the same spiritual food;
4 and all drank the same spiritual drink. For they drank of a spiritual rock that followed them, and the rock was Christ.
5 However with most of them, God was not well pleased, for they were overthrown in the wilderness.
6 Now these things were our examples, to the intent we should not lust after evil things as they also lusted.
7 Don't be idolaters, as some of them were. As it is written, "The people sat down to eat and drink, and rose up to play."*
8 Let's not commit sexual immorality, as some of them committed, and in one day twenty-three thousand fell.
9 Let's not test Christ,† as some of them tested, and perished by the serpents.
10 Don't grumble, as some of them also grumbled, and perished by the destroyer.
11 Now all these things happened to them by way of example, and they were written for our admonition, on whom the ends of the ages have come.
12 Therefore let him who thinks he stands be careful that he doesn't fall.
13 No temptation has taken you except what is common to man. God is faithful, who will not allow you to be tempted above what you are able, but will with the temptation also make the way of escape, that you may be able to endure it.
14 Therefore, my beloved, flee from idolatry.
15 I speak as to wise men. Judge what I say.
16 The cup of blessing which we bless, isn't it a sharing of the blood of Christ? The bread which we break, isn't it a sharing of the body of Christ?
17 Because there is one loaf of bread, we, who are many, are one body; for we all partake of the one loaf of bread.
18 Consider Israel according to the flesh. Don't those who eat the sacrifices participate in the altar?
19 What am I saying then? That a thing sacrificed to idols is anything, or that an idol is anything?
20 But I say that the things which the Gentiles sacrifice, they sacrifice to demons and not to God, and I don't desire that you would have fellowship with demons.
21 You can't both drink the cup of the Lord and the cup of demons. You can't both partake of the table of the Lord and of the table of demons.
22 Or do we provoke the Lord to jealousy? Are we stronger than he?
23 "All things are lawful for me," but not all things are profitable. "All things are lawful for me," but not all things build up.

† **9:20** NU adds: though I myself am not under the law of "Christ".

* **10:7** Exodus 32:6 † **10:9** NU reads "the Lord" instead

24 Let no one seek his own, but each one
his neighbor's good.
25 Whatever is sold in the butcher shop,
eat, asking no question for the sake of
conscience,
26 for "the earth is the Lord's, and its
fullness."*
27 But if one of those who don't believe
invites you to a meal, and you are inclined
to go, eat whatever is set before you,
asking no questions for the sake of
conscience.
28 But if anyone says to you, "This was
offered to idols," don't eat it for the sake of
the one who told you, and for the sake of
conscience. For "the earth is the Lord's,
with all its fullness."
29 Conscience, I say, not your own, but
the other's conscience. For why is my
liberty judged by another conscience?
30 If I partake with thankfulness, why
am I denounced for something I give
thanks for?
31 Whether therefore you eat or drink,
or whatever you do, do all to the glory of
God.
32 Give no occasion for stumbling,
whether to Jews, to Greeks, or to the
assembly of God;
33 even as I also please all men in all
things, not seeking my own profit, but the
profit of the many, that they may be saved.

11

1 Be imitators of me, even as I also am of
Christ.
2 Now I praise you, brothers, that you
remember me in all things, and hold firm
the traditions, even as I delivered them to
you.
3 But I would have you know that the
head† of every man is Christ, and the
head‡ of the woman is man, and the head§
of Christ is God.
4 Every man praying or prophesying,
having his head covered, dishonors his
head.
5 But every woman praying or
prophesying with her head uncovered
dishonors her head. For it is one and the
same thing as if she were shaved.
6 For if a woman is not covered, let her
hair also be cut off. But if it is shameful for
a woman to have her hair cut off or be
shaved, let her be covered.
7 For a man indeed ought not to have his
head covered, because he is the image and
glory of God, but the woman is the glory of
the man.
8 For man is not from woman, but
woman from man;
9 for man wasn't created for the woman,
but woman for the man.
10 For this cause the woman ought to
have authority over her own head,
because of the angels.
11 Nevertheless, neither is the woman
independent of the man, nor the man
independent of the woman, in the Lord.
12 For as woman came from man, so a
man also comes through a woman; but all
things are from God.
13 Judge for yourselves. Is it appropriate
that a woman pray to God unveiled?
14 Doesn't even nature itself teach you
that if a man has long hair, it is a dishonor
to him?
15 But if a woman has long hair, it is a
glory to her, for her hair is given to her for
a covering.
16 But if any man seems to be
contentious, we have no such custom,
neither do God's assemblies.
17 But in giving you this command I
don't praise you, because you come
together not for the better but for the
worse.
18 For first of all, when you come
together in the assembly, I hear that
divisions exist among you, and I partly
believe it.
19 For there also must be factions among
you, that those who are approved may be
revealed among you.
20 When therefore you assemble
yourselves together, it is not the Lord's
supper that you eat.
21 For in your eating each one takes his
own supper first. One is hungry, and
another is drunken.
22 What, don't you have houses to eat
and to drink in? Or do you despise God's

* **10:26** Psalms 24:1 † **11:3** or, origin ‡ **11:3** or, origin § **11:3** or, origin

assembly and put them to shame who don't have enough? What shall I tell you? Shall I praise you? In this I don't praise you.

23 For I received from the Lord that which also I delivered to you, that the Lord Jesus on the night in which he was betrayed took bread.
24 When he had given thanks, he broke it and said, "Take, eat. This is my body, which is broken for you. Do this in memory of me."
25 In the same way he also took the cup after supper, saying, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood. Do this, as often as you drink, in memory of me."
26 For as often as you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim the Lord's death until he comes.
27 Therefore whoever eats this bread or drinks the Lord's cup in a way unworthy of the Lord will be guilty of the body and the blood of the Lord.
28 But let a man examine himself, and so let him eat of the bread and drink of the cup.
29 For he who eats and drinks in an unworthy way eats and drinks judgment to himself if he doesn't discern the Lord's body.
30 For this cause many among you are weak and sickly, and not a few sleep.
31 For if we discerned ourselves, we wouldn't be judged.
32 But when we are judged, we are disciplined by the Lord, that we may not be condemned with the world.
33 Therefore, my brothers, when you come together to eat, wait for one another.
34 But if anyone is hungry, let him eat at home, lest your coming together be for judgment. The rest I will set in order whenever I come.

12

1 Now concerning spiritual things, brothers, I don't want you to be ignorant.
2 You know that when you were heathen,† you were led away to those mute idols, however you might be led.
3 Therefore I make known to you that no man speaking by God's Spirit says, "Jesus is accursed." No one can say, "Jesus is Lord," but by the Holy Spirit.

4 Now there are various kinds of gifts, but the same Spirit.
5 There are various kinds of service, and the same Lord.
6 There are various kinds of workings, but the same God who works all things in all.
7 But to each one is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the profit of all.
8 For to one is given through the Spirit the word of wisdom, and to another the word of knowledge according to the same Spirit,
9 to another faith by the same Spirit, and to another gifts of healings by the same Spirit,
10 and to another workings of miracles, and to another prophecy, and to another discerning of spirits, to another different kinds of languages, and to another the interpretation of languages.
11 But the one and the same Spirit produces all of these, distributing to each one separately as he desires.

12 For as the body is one and has many members, and all the members of the body, being many, are one body; so also is Christ.
13 For in one Spirit we were all baptized into one body, whether Jews or Greeks, whether bond or free; and were all given to drink into one Spirit.

14 For the body is not one member, but many.
15 If the foot would say, "Because I'm not the hand, I'm not part of the body," it is not therefore not part of the body.
16 If the ear would say, "Because I'm not the eye, I'm not part of the body," it's not therefore not part of the body.
17 If the whole body were an eye, where would the hearing be? If the whole were hearing, where would the smelling be?

† **12:2** or Gentiles

18 But now God has set the members,
each one of them, in the body, just as he
desired.
19 If they were all one member, where
would the body be?
20 But now they are many members, but
one body.
21 The eye can't tell the hand, "I have no
need for you," or again the head to the
feet, "I have no need for you."
22 No, much rather, those members of
the body which seem to be weaker are
necessary.
23 Those parts of the body which we
think to be less honorable, on those we
bestow more abundant honor; and our
unpresentable parts have more abundant
modesty,
24 while our presentable parts have no
such need. But God composed the body
together, giving more abundant honor to
the inferior part,
25 that there should be no division in the
body, but that the members should have
the same care for one another.
26 When one member suffers, all the
members suffer with it. When one
member is honored, all the members
rejoice with it.
27 Now you are the body of Christ, and
members individually.
28 God has set some in the assembly:
first apostles, second prophets, third
teachers, then miracle workers, then gifts
of healings, helps, governments, and
various kinds of languages.
29 Are all apostles? Are all prophets?
Are all teachers? Are all miracle workers?
30 Do all have gifts of healings? Do all
speak with various languages? Do all
interpret?
31 But earnestly desire the best gifts.
Moreover, I show a most excellent way to
you.

13

1 If I speak with the languages of men
and of angels, but don't have love, I have
become sounding brass or a clanging
cymbal.
2 If I have the gift of prophecy, and know
all mysteries and all knowledge, and if I
have all faith, so as to remove mountains,
but don't have love, I am nothing.
3 If I give away all my goods to feed the
poor, and if I give my body to be burned,
but don't have love, it profits me nothing.
4 Love is patient and is kind. Love
doesn't envy. Love doesn't brag, is not
proud,
5 doesn't behave itself inappropriately,
doesn't seek its own way, is not provoked,
takes no account of evil;
6 doesn't rejoice in unrighteousness, but
rejoices with the truth;
7 bears all things, believes all things,
hopes all things, and endures all things.
8 Love never fails. But where there are
prophecies, they will be done away with.
Where there are various languages, they
will cease. Where there is knowledge, it
will be done away with.
9 For we know in part and we prophesy
in part;
10 but when that which is complete has
come, then that which is partial will be
done away with.
11 When I was a child, I spoke as a child,
I felt as a child, I thought as a child. Now
that I have become a man, I have put
away childish things.
12 For now we see in a mirror, dimly,
but then face to face. Now I know in part,
but then I will know fully, even as I was
also fully known.
13 But now faith, hope, and love
remain—these three. The greatest of these
is love.

14

1 Follow after love and earnestly desire
spiritual gifts, but especially that you may
prophesy.
2 For he who speaks in another
language speaks not to men, but to God,
for no one understands, but in the Spirit
he speaks mysteries.
3 But he who prophesies speaks to men
for their edification, exhortation, and
consolation.
4 He who speaks in another language
edifies himself, but he who prophesies
edifies the assembly.

5 Now I desire to have you all speak with
other languages, but even more that you
would prophesy. For he is greater who
prophesies than he who speaks with other
languages, unless he interprets, that the
assembly may be built up.
6 But now, brothers,† if I come to you
speaking with other languages, what
would I profit you unless I speak to you
either by way of revelation, or of
knowledge, or of prophesying, or of
teaching?
7 Even lifeless things that make a sound,
whether pipe or harp, if they didn't give a
distinction in the sounds, how would it be
known what is piped or harped?
8 For if the trumpet gave an uncertain
sound, who would prepare himself for
war?
9 So also you, unless you uttered by the
tongue words easy to understand, how
would it be known what is spoken? For
you would be speaking into the air.
10 There are, it may be, so many kinds of
languages in the world, and none of them
is without meaning.
11 If then I don't know the meaning of
the language, I would be to him who
speaks a foreigner, and he who speaks
would be a foreigner to me.
12 So also you, since you are zealous for
spiritual gifts, seek that you may abound
to the building up of the assembly.
13 Therefore let him who speaks in
another language pray that he may
interpret.
14 For if I pray in another language, my
spirit prays, but my understanding is
unfruitful.
15 What should I do? I will pray with the
spirit, and I will pray with the
understanding also. I will sing with the
spirit, and I will sing with the
understanding also.
16 Otherwise, if you bless with the spirit,
how will he who fills the place of the
unlearned say the "Amen" at your giving
of thanks, seeing he doesn't know what
you say?
17 For you most certainly give thanks
well, but the other person is not built up.
18 I thank my God, I speak with other
languages more than you all.
19 However, in the assembly I would
rather speak five words with my
understanding, that I might instruct
others also, than ten thousand words in
another language.
20 Brothers, don't be children in
thoughts, yet in malice be babies, but in
thoughts be mature.
21 In the law it is written, "By men of
strange languages and by the lips of
strangers I will speak to this people. They
won't even listen to me that way, says the
Lord."*
22 Therefore other languages are for a
sign, not to those who believe, but to the
unbelieving; but prophesying is for a sign,
not to the unbelieving, but to those who
believe.
23 If therefore the whole assembly is
assembled together and all speak with
other languages, and unlearned or
unbelieving people come in, won't they
say that you are crazy?
24 But if all prophesy, and someone
unbelieving or unlearned comes in, he is
reproved by all, and he is judged by all.
25 And thus the secrets of his heart are
revealed. So he will fall down on his face
and worship God, declaring that God is
among you indeed.
26 What is it then, brothers? When you
come together, each one of you has a
psalm, has a teaching, has a revelation,
has another language, or has an
interpretation. Let all things be done to
build each other up.
27 If any man speaks in another
language, let there be two, or at the most
three, and in turn; and let one interpret.
28 But if there is no interpreter, let him
keep silent in the assembly, and let him
speak to himself and to God.
29 Let two or three of the prophets
speak, and let the others discern.

† **14:6** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **14:21** Isaiah 28:11-12

30 But if a revelation is made to another
sitting by, let the first keep silent.
31 For you all can prophesy one by one,
that all may learn and all may be
exhorted.
32 The spirits of the prophets are subject
to the prophets,
33 for God is not a God of confusion but
of peace, as in all the assemblies of the
saints.
34 Let the wives be quiet in the
assemblies, for it has not been permitted
for them to be talking except in
submission, as the law also says,*
35 if they desire to learn anything. "Let
them ask their own husbands at home, for
it is shameful for a wife to be talking in
the assembly."
36 What!? Was it from you that the word
of God went out? Or did it come to you
alone?
37 If any man thinks himself to be a
prophet or spiritual, let him recognize the
things which I write to you, that they are
the commandment of the Lord.
38 But if anyone is ignorant, let him be
ignorant.
39 Therefore, brothers, desire earnestly
to prophesy, and don't forbid speaking
with other languages.
40 Let all things be done decently and in
order.

15

1 Now I declare to you, brothers, the
Good News which I preached to you,
which also you received, in which you
also stand,
2 by which also you are saved, if you
hold firmly the word which I preached to
you—unless you believed in vain.
3 For I delivered to you first of all that
which I also received: that Christ died for
our sins according to the Scriptures,
4 that he was buried, that he was raised
on the third day according to the
Scriptures,
5 and that he appeared to Cephas, then
to the twelve.
6 Then he appeared to over five
hundred brothers at once, most of whom
remain until now, but some have also
fallen asleep.
7 Then he appeared to James, then to all
the apostles,
8 and last of all, as to the child born at
the wrong time, he appeared to me also.
9 For I am the least of the apostles, who
is not worthy to be called an apostle,
because I persecuted the assembly of God.
10 But by the grace of God I am what I
am. His grace which was given to me was
not futile, but I worked more than all of
them; yet not I, but the grace of God which
was with me.
11 Whether then it is I or they, so we
preach, and so you believed.

12 Now if Christ is preached, that he has
been raised from the dead, how do some
among you say that there is no
resurrection of the dead?
13 But if there is no resurrection of the
dead, neither has Christ been raised.
14 If Christ has not been raised, then our
preaching is in vain and your faith also is
in vain.
15 Yes, we are also found false witnesses
of God, because we testified about God
that he raised up Christ, whom he didn't
raise up if it is true that the dead are not
raised.
16 For if the dead aren't raised, neither
has Christ been raised.
17 If Christ has not been raised, your
faith is vain; you are still in your sins.
18 Then they also who are fallen asleep
in Christ have perished.
19 If we have only hoped in Christ in this
life, we are of all men most pitiable.

20 But now Christ has been raised from
the dead. He became the first fruit of
those who are asleep.
21 For since death came by man, the
resurrection of the dead also came by
man.
22 For as in Adam all die, so also in
Christ all will be made alive.
23 But each in his own order: Christ the
first fruits, then those who are Christ's at
his coming.
24 Then the end comes, when he will
deliver up the Kingdom to God the Father,

* **14:34** Deuteronomy 27:9

when he will have abolished all rule and all authority and power.
25 For he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet.
26 The last enemy that will be abolished is death.
27 For, “He put all things in subjection under his feet.”* But when he says, “All things are put in subjection”, it is evident that he is excepted who subjected all things to him.
28 When all things have been subjected to him, then the Son will also himself be subjected to him who subjected all things to him, that God may be all in all.
29 Or else what will they do who are baptized for the dead? If the dead aren’t raised at all, why then are they baptized for the dead?
30 Why do we also stand in jeopardy every hour?
31 I affirm, by the boasting in you which I have in Christ Jesus our Lord, I die daily.
32 If I fought with animals at Ephesus for human purposes, what does it profit me? If the dead are not raised, then “let’s eat and drink, for tomorrow we die.”*
33 Don’t be deceived! “Evil companionships corrupt good morals.”
34 Wake up righteously and don’t sin, for some have no knowledge of God. I say this to your shame.
35 But someone will say, “How are the dead raised?” and, “With what kind of body do they come?”
36 You foolish one, that which you yourself sow is not made alive unless it dies.
37 That which you sow, you don’t sow the body that will be, but a bare grain, maybe of wheat, or of some other kind.
38 But God gives it a body even as it pleased him, and to each seed a body of its own.
39 All flesh is not the same flesh, but there is one flesh of men, another flesh of animals, another of fish, and another of birds.
40 There are also celestial bodies and terrestrial bodies; but the glory of the celestial differs from that of the terrestrial.
41 There is one glory of the sun, another glory of the moon, and another glory of the stars; for one star differs from another star in glory.
42 So also is the resurrection of the dead. The body is sown perishable; it is raised imperishable.
43 It is sown in dishonor; it is raised in glory. It is sown in weakness; it is raised in power.
44 It is sown a natural body; it is raised a spiritual body. There is a natural body and there is also a spiritual body.
45 So also it is written, “The first man Adam became a living soul.”* The last Adam became a life-giving spirit.
46 However, that which is spiritual isn’t first, but that which is natural, then that which is spiritual.
47 The first man is of the earth, made of dust. The second man is the Lord from heaven.
48 As is the one made of dust, such are those who are also made of dust; and as is the heavenly, such are they also that are heavenly.
49 As we have borne the image of those made of dust, let’s† also bear the image of the heavenly.
50 Now I say this, brothers,‡ that flesh and blood can’t inherit God’s Kingdom; neither does the perishable inherit imperishable.
51 Behold,§ I tell you a mystery. We will not all sleep, but we will all be changed,
52 in a moment, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound and the dead will be raised incorruptible, and we will be changed.
53 For this perishable body must become imperishable, and this mortal must put on immortality.
54 But when this perishable body will have become imperishable, and this

* **15:27** Psalms 8:6 * **15:32** Isaiah 22:13 * **15:45** Genesis 2:7 † **15:49** NU, TR read “we will” instead of “let’s” ‡ **15:50** The word for “brothers” here and where context allows may also be correctly translated “brothers and sisters” or “siblings.” § **15:51** “Behold”, from “ἰδοὺ”, means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

mortal will have put on immortality, then what is written will happen: “Death is swallowed up in victory.”*
55 “Death, where is your sting?
Hades,† where is your victory?”*
56 The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law.
57 But thanks be to God, who gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ.
58 Therefore, my beloved brothers, be steadfast, immovable, always abounding in the Lord’s work, because you know that your labor is not in vain in the Lord.

16

1 Now concerning the collection for the saints: as I commanded the assemblies of Galatia, you do likewise.
2 On the first day of every week, let each one of you save as he may prosper, that no collections are made when I come.
3 When I arrive, I will send whoever you approve with letters to carry your gracious gift to Jerusalem.
4 If it is appropriate for me to go also, they will go with me.
5 I will come to you when I have passed through Macedonia, for I am passing through Macedonia.
6 But with you it may be that I will stay with you, or even winter with you, that you may send me on my journey wherever I go.
7 For I do not wish to see you now in passing, but I hope to stay a while with you, if the Lord permits.
8 But I will stay at Ephesus until Pentecost,
9 for a great and effective door has opened to me, and there are many adversaries.
10 Now if Timothy comes, see that he is with you without fear, for he does the work of the Lord, as I also do.
11 Therefore let no one despise him. But set him forward on his journey in peace, that he may come to me; for I expect him with the brothers.
12 Now concerning Apollos the brother, I strongly urged him to come to you with the brothers, but it was not at all his desire to come now; but he will come when he has an opportunity.
13 Watch! Stand firm in the faith! Be courageous! Be strong!
14 Let all that you do be done in love.
15 Now I beg you, brothers—you know the house of Stephanas, that it is the first fruits of Achaia, and that they have set themselves to serve the saints—
16 that you also be in subjection to such, and to everyone who helps in the work and labors.
17 I rejoice at the coming of Stephanas, Fortunatus, and Achaicus; for that which was lacking on your part, they supplied.
18 For they refreshed my spirit and yours. Therefore acknowledge those who are like that.
19 The assemblies of Asia greet you. Aquila and Priscilla greet you warmly in the Lord, together with the assembly that is in their house.
20 All the brothers greet you. Greet one another with a holy kiss.
21 This greeting is by me, Paul, with my own hand.
22 If any man doesn’t love the Lord Jesus Christ, let him be cursed.† Come, Lord!‡
23 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be with you.
24 My love to all of you in Christ Jesus. Amen.

* **15:54** Isaiah 25:8 † **15:55** or, Hell * **15:55** See Hosea 13:14 † **16:22** Greek: anathema. ‡ **16:22** Aramaic: Maranatha!

Paul's Second Letter to the Corinthians

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ† Jesus
through the will of God, and Timothy our
brother, to the assembly of God which is
at Corinth, with all the saints who are in
the whole of Achaia:
2 Grace to you and peace from God our
Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.

3 Blessed be the God and Father of our
Lord Jesus Christ, the Father of mercies
and God of all comfort,
4 who comforts us in all our affliction,
that we may be able to comfort those who
are in any affliction, through the comfort
with which we ourselves are comforted
by God.
5 For as the sufferings of Christ abound
to us, even so our comfort also abounds
through Christ.
6 But if we are afflicted, it is for your
comfort and salvation. If we are
comforted, it is for your comfort, which
produces in you the patient enduring of
the same sufferings which we also suffer.
7 Our hope for you is steadfast, knowing
that, since you are partakers of the
sufferings, so you are also of the comfort.

8 For we don't desire to have you
uninformed, brothers,‡ concerning our
affliction which happened to us in Asia:
that we were weighed down exceedingly,
beyond our power, so much that we
despaired even of life.
9 Yes, we ourselves have had the
sentence of death within ourselves, that
we should not trust in ourselves, but in
God who raises the dead,
10 who delivered us out of so great a
death, and does deliver, on whom we
have set our hope that he will also still
deliver us,
11 you also helping together on our
behalf by your supplication; that, for the
gift given to us by means of many, thanks
may be given by many persons on your§
behalf.
12 For our boasting is this: the testimony
of our conscience that in holiness and
sincerity of God, not in fleshly wisdom but
in the grace of God, we behaved ourselves
in the world, and more abundantly
toward you.
13 For we write no other things to you
than what you read or even acknowledge,
and I hope you will acknowledge to the
end—
14 as also you acknowledged us in
part—that we are your boasting, even as
you also are ours, in the day of our Lord
Jesus.

15 In this confidence, I was determined
to come first to you, that you might have a
second benefit,
16 and by you to pass into Macedonia,
and again from Macedonia to come to
you, and to be sent forward by you on my
journey to Judea.
17 When I therefore planned this, did I
show fickleness? Or the things that I plan,
do I plan according to the flesh, that with
me there should be the "Yes, yes" and the
"No, no?"
18 But as God is faithful, our word
toward you was not "Yes and no."
19 For the Son of God, Jesus Christ, who
was preached among you by us—by me,
Silvanus, and Timothy—was not "Yes and
no," but in him is "Yes."
20 For however many are the promises
of God, in him is the "Yes." Therefore also
through him is the "Amen", to the glory of
God through us.

21 Now he who establishes us with you
in Christ and anointed us is God,
22 who also sealed us and gave us the
down payment of the Spirit in our hearts.

23 But I call God for a witness to my soul,
that to spare you, I didn't come to Corinth.
24 We don't control your faith, but are
fellow workers with you for your joy. For
you stand firm in faith.

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:8** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." § **1:11** + MT: your; TR and NU: our

2

1 But I determined this for myself, that I
would not come to you again in sorrow.
2 For if I make you grieve, then who will
make me glad but he who is made to
grieve by me?
3 And I wrote this very thing to you, so
that when I came, I wouldn't have sorrow
from them of whom I ought to rejoice;
having confidence in you all that my joy
would be shared by all of you.
4 For out of much affliction and anguish
of heart I wrote to you with many tears,
not that you should be made to grieve, but
that you might know the love that I have
so abundantly for you.

5 But if any has caused sorrow, he has
caused sorrow not to me, but in part (that
I not press too heavily) to you all.
6 This punishment which was inflicted
by the many is sufficient for such a one;
7 so that, on the contrary, you should
rather forgive him and comfort him, lest
by any means such a one should be
swallowed up with his excessive sorrow.
8 Therefore I beg you to confirm your
love toward him.
9 For to this end I also wrote, that I
might know the proof of you, whether you
are obedient in all things.
10 Now I also forgive whomever you
forgive anything. For if indeed I have
forgiven anything, I have forgiven that
one for your sakes in the presence of
Christ,
11 that no advantage may be gained
over us by Satan, for we are not ignorant
of his schemes.

12 Now when I came to Troas for the
Good News of Christ, and when a door
was opened to me in the Lord,
13 I had no relief for my spirit, because I
didn't find Titus my brother, but taking
my leave of them, I went out into
Macedonia.

14 Now thanks be to God who always
leads us in triumph in Christ, and reveals
through us the sweet aroma of his
knowledge in every place.
15 For we are a sweet aroma of Christ to
God in those who are being saved and in
those who perish:
16 to the one a stench from death to
death, to the other a sweet aroma from life
to life. Who is sufficient for these things?
17 For we are not as so many, peddling
the word of God. But as of sincerity, but as
of God, in the sight of God, we speak in
Christ.

3

1 Are we beginning again to commend
ourselves? Or do we need, as do some,
letters of commendation to you or from
you?
2 You are our letter, written in our
hearts, known and read by all men,
3 being revealed that you are a letter of
Christ, served by us, written not with ink,
but with the Spirit of the living God; not in
tablets of stone, but in tablets that are
hearts of flesh.
4 Such confidence we have through
Christ toward God,
5 not that we are sufficient of ourselves
to account anything as from ourselves;
but our sufficiency is from God,
6 who also made us sufficient as
servants of a new covenant, not of the
letter but of the Spirit. For the letter kills,
but the Spirit gives life.

7 But if the service of death, written
engraved on stones, came with glory, so
that the children of Israel could not look
steadfastly on the face of Moses for the
glory of his face, which was passing away,
8 won't service of the Spirit be with
much more glory?
9 For if the service of condemnation has
glory, the service of righteousness
exceeds much more in glory.
10 For most certainly that which has
been made glorious has not been made
glorious in this respect, by reason of the
glory that surpasses.
11 For if that which passes away was
with glory, much more that which
remains is in glory.

12 Having therefore such a hope, we use
great boldness of speech,

13 and not as Moses, who put a veil on
his face so that the children of Israel
wouldn't look steadfastly on the end of
that which was passing away.
14 But their minds were hardened, for
until this very day at the reading of the old
covenant the same veil remains, because
in Christ it passes away.
15 But to this day, when Moses is read, a
veil lies on their heart.
16 But whenever someone turns to the
Lord, the veil is taken away.
17 Now the Lord is the Spirit; and where
the Spirit of the Lord is, there is liberty.
18 But we all, with unveiled face seeing
the glory of the Lord as in a mirror, are
transformed into the same image from
glory to glory, even as from the Lord, the
Spirit.

4

1 Therefore, seeing we have this
ministry, even as we obtained mercy, we
don't faint.
2 But we have renounced the hidden
things of shame, not walking in craftiness
nor handling the word of God deceitfully,
but by the manifestation of the truth
commending ourselves to every man's
conscience in the sight of God.
3 Even if our Good News is veiled, it is
veiled in those who are dying,
4 in whom the god of this world has
blinded the minds of the unbelieving, that
the light of the Good News of the glory of
Christ, who is the image of God, should
not dawn on them.
5 For we don't preach ourselves, but
Christ Jesus as Lord, and ourselves as
your servants for Jesus' sake,
6 seeing it is God who said, "Light will
shine out of darkness,"* who has shone in
our hearts to give the light of the
knowledge of the glory of God in the face
of Jesus Christ.
7 But we have this treasure in clay
vessels, that the exceeding greatness of
the power may be of God and not from
ourselves.
8 We are pressed on every side, yet not
crushed; perplexed, yet not to despair;
9 pursued, yet not forsaken; struck
down, yet not destroyed;
10 always carrying in the body the
putting to death of the Lord Jesus, that the
life of Jesus may also be revealed in our
body.
11 For we who live are always delivered
to death for Jesus' sake, that the life also of
Jesus may be revealed in our mortal flesh.
12 So then death works in us, but life in
you.
13 But having the same spirit of faith,
according to that which is written, "I
believed, and therefore I spoke."* We also
believe, and therefore we also speak,
14 knowing that he who raised the Lord
Jesus will raise us also through† Jesus, and
will present us with you.
15 For all things are for your sakes, that
the grace, being multiplied through the
many, may cause the thanksgiving to
abound to the glory of God.
16 Therefore we don't faint, but though
our outward person is decaying, yet our
inward person is renewed day by day.
17 For our light affliction, which is for
the moment, works for us more and more
exceedingly an eternal weight of glory,
18 while we don't look at the things
which are seen, but at the things which
are not seen. For the things which are
seen are temporal, but the things which
are not seen are eternal.

5

1 For we know that if the earthly house
of our tent is dissolved, we have a
building from God, a house not made with
hands, eternal, in the heavens.
2 For most certainly in this we groan,
longing to be clothed with our habitation
which is from heaven,
3 if indeed being clothed, we will not be
found naked.
4 For indeed we who are in this tent do
groan, being burdened, not that we desire
to be unclothed, but that we desire to be

* **4:6** Genesis 1:3 * **4:13** Psalms 116:10 † **4:14** NU reads *with* instead of *through*.

clothed, that what is mortal may be swallowed up by life.
5 Now he who made us for this very thing is God, who also gave to us the down payment of the Spirit.
6 Therefore we are always confident and know that while we are at home in the body, we are absent from the Lord;
7 for we walk by faith, not by sight.
8 We are courageous, I say, and are willing rather to be absent from the body and to be at home with the Lord.
9 Therefore also we make it our aim, whether at home or absent, to be well pleasing to him.
10 For we must all be revealed before the judgment seat of Christ that each one may receive the things in the body according to what he has done, whether good or bad.
11 Knowing therefore the fear of the Lord, we persuade men, but we are revealed to God, and I hope that we are revealed also in your consciences.
12 For we are not commending ourselves to you again, but speak as giving you occasion of boasting on our behalf, that you may have something to answer those who boast in appearance and not in heart.
13 For if we are beside ourselves, it is for God. Or if we are of sober mind, it is for you.
14 For the love of Christ compels us; because we judge thus: that one died for all, therefore all died.
15 He died for all, that those who live should no longer live to themselves, but to him who for their sakes died and rose again.
16 Therefore we know no one according to the flesh from now on. Even though we have known Christ according to the flesh, yet now we know him so no more.
17 Therefore if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation. The old things have passed away. Behold,† all things have become new.
18 But all things are of God, who reconciled us to himself through Jesus Christ, and gave to us the ministry of reconciliation;
19 namely, that God was in Christ reconciling the world to himself, not reckoning to them their trespasses, and having committed to us the word of reconciliation.
20 We are therefore ambassadors on behalf of Christ, as though God were entreating by us: we beg you on behalf of Christ, be reconciled to God.
21 For him who knew no sin he made to be sin on our behalf, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.

6

1 Working together, we entreat also that you do not receive the grace of God in vain.
2 For he says,
"At an acceptable time I listened to you.
In a day of salvation I helped you."*
Behold, now is the acceptable time.
Behold, now is the day of salvation.
3 We give no occasion of stumbling in anything, that our service may not be blamed,
4 but in everything commending ourselves as servants of God: in great endurance, in afflictions, in hardships, in distresses,
5 in beatings, in imprisonments, in riots, in labors, in watchings, in fastings,
6 in pureness, in knowledge, in perseverance, in kindness, in the Holy Spirit, in sincere love,
7 in the word of truth, in the power of God, by the armor of righteousness on the right hand and on the left,
8 by glory and dishonor, by evil report and good report, as deceivers and yet true,
9 as unknown and yet well known, as dying and behold—we live, as punished and not killed,
10 as sorrowful yet always rejoicing, as poor yet making many rich, as having nothing and yet possessing all things.
11 Our mouth is open to you, Corinthians. Our heart is enlarged.

† **5:17** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.
* **6:2** Isaiah 49:8

12 You are not restricted by us, but you
are restricted by your own affections.
13 Now in return—I speak as to my
children—you also open your hearts.
14 Don't be unequally yoked with
unbelievers, for what fellowship do
righteousness and iniquity have? Or what
fellowship does light have with darkness?
15 What agreement does Christ have
with Belial? Or what portion does a
believer have with an unbeliever?
16 What agreement does a temple of God
have with idols? For you are a temple of
the living God. Even as God said, "I will
dwell in them and walk in them. I will be
their God and they will be my people."*
17 Therefore
" 'Come out from among them,
and be separate,' says the Lord.
'Touch no unclean thing.
I will receive you.*
18 I will be to you a Father.
You will be to me sons and daughters,'
says the Lord Almighty."*

7

1 Having therefore these promises,
beloved, let's cleanse ourselves from all
defilement of flesh and spirit, perfecting
holiness in the fear of God.
2 Open your hearts to us. We wronged
no one. We corrupted no one. We took
advantage of no one.
3 I say this not to condemn you, for I
have said before that you are in our
hearts to die together and live together.
4 Great is my boldness of speech toward
you. Great is my boasting on your behalf.
I am filled with comfort. I overflow with
joy in all our affliction.
5 For even when we had come into
Macedonia, our flesh had no relief, but we
were afflicted on every side. Fightings
were outside. Fear was inside.
6 Nevertheless, he who comforts the
lowly, God, comforted us by the coming of
Titus,
7 and not by his coming only, but also by
the comfort with which he was comforted
in you while he told us of your longing,
your mourning, and your zeal for me, so
that I rejoiced still more.
8 For though I grieved you with my
letter, I do not regret it, though I did regret
it. For I see that my letter made you
grieve, though just for a while.
9 I now rejoice, not that you were
grieved, but that you were grieved to
repentance. For you were grieved in a
godly way, that you might suffer loss by us
in nothing.
10 For godly sorrow produces
repentance leading to salvation, which
brings no regret. But the sorrow of the
world produces death.
11 For behold, this same thing, that you
were grieved in a godly way, what earnest
care it worked in you. Yes, what defense,
indignation, fear, longing, zeal, and
vindication! In everything you
demonstrated yourselves to be pure in the
matter.
12 So although I wrote to you, I wrote
not for his cause that did the wrong, nor
for his cause that suffered the wrong, but
that your earnest care for us might be
revealed in you in the sight of God.
13 Therefore we have been comforted.
In our comfort we rejoiced the more
exceedingly for the joy of Titus, because
his spirit has been refreshed by you all.
14 For if in anything I have boasted to
him on your behalf, I was not
disappointed. But as we spoke all things to
you in truth, so our glorying also which I
made before Titus was found to be truth.
15 His affection is more abundantly
toward you, while he remembers all of
your obedience, how with fear and
trembling you received him.
16 I rejoice that in everything I am
confident concerning you.

8

1 Moreover, brothers, we make known
to you the grace of God which has been
given in the assemblies of Macedonia,
2 how in a severe ordeal of affliction, the
abundance of their joy and their deep

* **6:16** Leviticus 26:12; Jeremiah 32:38; Ezekiel 37:27 * **6:17** Isaiah 52:11; Ezekiel 20:34,41 * **6:18** 2 Samuel 7:14; 7:8

poverty abounded to the riches of their generosity.
3 For according to their power, I testify, yes and beyond their power, they gave of their own accord,
4 begging us with much entreaty to receive this grace and the fellowship in the service to the saints.
5 This was not as we had expected, but first they gave their own selves to the Lord, and to us through the will of God.
6 So we urged Titus, that as he had made a beginning before, so he would also complete in you this grace.
7 But as you abound in everything—in faith, utterance, knowledge, all earnestness, and in your love to us—see that you also abound in this grace.

8 I speak not by way of commandment, but as proving through the earnestness of others the sincerity also of your love.
9 For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that you through his poverty might become rich.
10 I give advice in this: it is expedient for you who were the first to start a year ago, not only to do, but also to be willing.
11 But now complete the doing also, that as there was the readiness to be willing, so there may be the completion also out of your ability.
12 For if the readiness is there, it is acceptable according to what you have, not according to what you don't have.
13 For this is not that others may be eased and you distressed,
14 but for equality. Your abundance at this present time supplies their lack, that their abundance also may become a supply for your lack, that there may be equality.
15 As it is written, "He who gathered much had nothing left over, and he who gathered little had no lack."*

16 But thanks be to God, who puts the same earnest care for you into the heart of Titus.
17 For he indeed accepted our exhortation, but being himself very earnest, he went out to you of his own accord.
18 We have sent together with him the brother whose praise in the Good News is known throughout all the assemblies.
19 Not only so, but he was also appointed by the assemblies to travel with us in this grace, which is served by us to the glory of the Lord himself, and to show our readiness.
20 We are avoiding this, that any man should blame us concerning this abundance which is administered by us.
21 Having regard for honorable things, not only in the sight of the Lord, but also in the sight of men.
22 We have sent with them our brother whom we have many times proved earnest in many things, but now much more earnest, by reason of the great confidence which he has in you.
23 As for Titus, he is my partner and fellow worker for you. As for our brothers, they are the apostles of the assemblies, the glory of Christ.
24 Therefore show the proof of your love to them before the assemblies, and of our boasting on your behalf.

9

1 It is indeed unnecessary for me to write to you concerning the service to the saints,
2 for I know your readiness, of which I boast on your behalf to those of Macedonia, that Achaia has been prepared for the past year. Your zeal has stirred up very many of them.
3 But I have sent the brothers so that our boasting on your behalf may not be in vain in this respect, that, just as I said, you may be prepared,
4 lest by any means, if anyone from Macedonia comes there with me and finds you unprepared, we (to say nothing of you) would be disappointed in this confident boasting.

* **8:15** Exodus 16:18

5 I thought it necessary therefore to
entreat the brothers that they would go
before to you and arrange ahead of time
the generous gift that you promised
before, that the same might be ready as a
matter of generosity, and not of
greediness.
6 Remember this: he who sows
sparingly will also reap sparingly. He who
sows bountifully will also reap
bountifully.
7 Let each man give according as he has
determined in his heart, not grudgingly or
under compulsion, for God loves a
cheerful giver.
8 And God is able to make all grace
abound to you, that you, always having all
sufficiency in everything, may abound to
every good work.
9 As it is written,
"He has scattered abroad. He has given to
the poor.
His righteousness remains forever."*
10 Now may he who supplies seed to the
sower and bread for food, supply and
multiply your seed for sowing, and
increase the fruits of your righteousness,
11 you being enriched in everything for
all generosity, which produces
thanksgiving to God through us.
12 For this service of giving that you
perform not only makes up for lack
among the saints, but abounds also
through much giving of thanks to God,
13 seeing that through the proof given
by this service, they glorify God for the
obedience of your confession to the Good
News of Christ and for the generosity of
your contribution to them and to all,
14 while they themselves also, with
supplication on your behalf, yearn for you
by reason of the exceeding grace of God in
you.
15 Now thanks be to God for his
unspeakable gift!

10

1 Now I Paul, myself, entreat you by the
humility and gentleness of Christ, I who in
your presence am lowly among you, but
being absent am bold toward you.
2 Yes, I beg you that I may not, when
present, show courage with the
confidence with which I intend to be bold
against some, who consider us to be
walking according to the flesh.
3 For though we walk in the flesh, we
don't wage war according to the flesh;
4 for the weapons of our warfare are not
of the flesh, but mighty before God to the
throwing down of strongholds,
5 throwing down imaginations and
every high thing that is exalted against
the knowledge of God and bringing every
thought into captivity to the obedience of
Christ,
6 and being in readiness to avenge all
disobedience when your obedience is
made full.
7 Do you look at things only as they
appear in front of your face? If anyone
trusts in himself that he is Christ's, let him
consider this again with himself, that even
as he is Christ's, so we also are Christ's.
8 For even if I boast somewhat
abundantly concerning our authority,
which the Lord gave for building you up
and not for casting you down, I will not be
ashamed,
9 that I may not seem as if I desire to
terrify you by my letters.
10 For, "His letters", they say, "are
weighty and strong, but his bodily
presence is weak, and his speech is
despised."
11 Let such a person consider this, that
what we are in word by letters when we
are absent, such are we also in deed when
we are present.
12 For we are not bold to number or
compare ourselves with some of those
who commend themselves. But they
themselves, measuring themselves by
themselves, and comparing themselves
with themselves, are without
understanding.
13 But we will not boast beyond proper
limits, but within the boundaries with
which God appointed to us, which reach
even to you.

* **9:9** Psalms 112:9

14 For we don't stretch ourselves too
much, as though we didn't reach to you.
For we came even as far as to you with the
Good News of Christ,
15 not boasting beyond proper limits in
other men's labors, but having hope that
as your faith grows, we will be
abundantly enlarged by you in our sphere
of influence,
16 so as to preach the Good News even to
the parts beyond you, not to boast in what
someone else has already done.
17 But "he who boasts, let him boast in
the Lord."*
18 For it isn't he who commends himself
who is approved, but whom the Lord
commends.

11

1 I wish that you would bear with me in
a little foolishness, but indeed you do bear
with me.
2 For I am jealous over you with a godly
jealousy. For I promised you in marriage
to one husband, that I might present you
as a pure virgin to Christ.
3 But I am afraid that somehow, as the
serpent deceived Eve in his craftiness, so
your minds might be corrupted from the
simplicity that is in Christ.
4 For if he who comes preaches another
Jesus whom we didn't preach, or if you
receive a different spirit which you didn't
receive, or a different "good news" which
you didn't accept, you put up with that
well enough.
5 For I reckon that I am not at all behind
the very best apostles.
6 But though I am unskilled in speech,
yet I am not unskilled in knowledge. No,
in every way we have been revealed to
you in all things.
7 Or did I commit a sin in humbling
myself that you might be exalted, because
I preached to you God's Good News free of
charge?
8 I robbed other assemblies, taking
wages from them that I might serve you.
9 When I was present with you and was
in need, I wasn't a burden on anyone, for
the brothers, when they came from
Macedonia, supplied the measure of my
need. In everything I kept myself from
being burdensome to you, and I will
continue to do so.
10 As the truth of Christ is in me, no one
will stop me from this boasting in the
regions of Achaia.
11 Why? Because I don't love you? God
knows.
12 But what I do, that I will continue to
do, that I may cut off opportunity from
those who desire an opportunity, that in
which they boast, they may be recognized
just like us.
13 For such men are false apostles,
deceitful workers, masquerading as
Christ's apostles.
14 And no wonder, for even Satan
masquerades as an angel of light.
15 It is no great thing therefore if his
servants also masquerade as servants of
righteousness, whose end will be
according to their works.
16 I say again, let no one think me
foolish. But if so, yet receive me as foolish,
that I also may boast a little.
17 That which I speak, I don't speak
according to the Lord, but as in
foolishness, in this confidence of boasting.
18 Seeing that many boast after the flesh,
I will also boast.
19 For you bear with the foolish gladly,
being wise.
20 For you bear with a man if he brings
you into bondage, if he devours you, if he
takes you captive, if he exalts himself, or if
he strikes you on the face.
21 To my shame, I speak as though we
had been weak. Yet in whatever way
anyone is bold (I speak in foolishness), I
am bold also.
22 Are they Hebrews? So am I. Are they
Israelites? So am I. Are they the offspring†
of Abraham? So am I.
23 Are they servants of Christ? (I speak
as one beside himself.) I am more so: in
labors more abundantly, in prisons more
abundantly, in stripes above measure,
and in deaths often.

* **10:17** Jeremiah 9:24 † **11:22** or, seed

24 Five times I received forty stripes
minus one from the Jews.
25 Three times I was beaten with rods.
Once I was stoned. Three times I suffered
shipwreck. I have been a night and a day
in the deep.
26 I have been in travels often, perils of
rivers, perils of robbers, perils from my
countrymen, perils from the Gentiles,
perils in the city, perils in the wilderness,
perils in the sea, perils among false
brothers;
27 in labor and travail, in watchings
often, in hunger and thirst, in fastings
often, and in cold and nakedness.
28 Besides those things that are outside,
there is that which presses on me daily:
anxiety for all the assemblies.
29 Who is weak, and I am not weak?
Who is caused to stumble, and I don't
burn with indignation?
30 If I must boast, I will boast of the
things that concern my weakness.
31 The God and Father of the Lord Jesus
Christ, he who is blessed forever more,
knows that I don't lie.
32 In Damascus the governor under
King Aretas guarded the Damascenes'
city, desiring to arrest me.
33 I was let down in a basket through a
window by the wall, and escaped his
hands.

12

1 It is doubtless not profitable for me to
boast, but I will come to visions and
revelations of the Lord.
2 I know a man in Christ who was
caught up into the third heaven fourteen
years ago—whether in the body, I don't
know, or whether out of the body, I don't
know; God knows.
3 I know such a man (whether in the
body, or outside of the body, I don't know;
God knows),
4 how he was caught up into Paradise
and heard unspeakable words, which it is
not lawful for a man to utter.
5 On behalf of such a one I will boast,
but on my own behalf I will not boast,
except in my weaknesses.
6 For if I would desire to boast, I will not
be foolish; for I will speak the truth. But I
refrain, so that no man may think more of
me than that which he sees in me or hears
from me.
7 By reason of the exceeding greatness
of the revelations, that I should not be
exalted excessively, a thorn in the flesh
was given to me: a messenger of Satan to
torment me, that I should not be exalted
excessively.
8 Concerning this thing, I begged the
Lord three times that it might depart from
me.
9 He has said to me, "My grace is
sufficient for you, for my power is made
perfect in weakness." Most gladly
therefore I will rather glory in my
weaknesses, that the power of Christ may
rest on me.
10 Therefore I take pleasure in
weaknesses, in injuries, in necessities, in
persecutions, and in distresses, for
Christ's sake. For when I am weak, then
am I strong.
11 I have become foolish in boasting.
You compelled me, for I ought to have
been commended by you, for I am in no
way inferior to the very best apostles,
though I am nothing.
12 Truly the signs of an apostle were
worked among you in all perseverance, in
signs and wonders and mighty works.
13 For what is there in which you were
made inferior to the rest of the
assemblies, unless it is that I myself was
not a burden to you? Forgive me this
wrong!
14 Behold, this is the third time I am
ready to come to you, and I will not be a
burden to you; for I seek not your
possessions, but you. For the children
ought not to save up for the parents, but
the parents for the children.
15 I will most gladly spend and be spent
for your souls. If I love you more
abundantly, am I loved the less?
16 Even so, I myself didn't burden you.
But you might say that being crafty, I
caught you with deception.
17 Did I take advantage of you by anyone
of those whom I have sent to you?
18 I exhorted Titus, and I sent the
brother with him. Did Titus take any

advantage of you? Didn't we walk in the same spirit? Didn't we walk in the same steps?
19 Again, do you think that we are excusing ourselves to you? In the sight of God we speak in Christ. But all things, beloved, are for your edifying.
20 For I am afraid that perhaps when I come, I might find you not the way I want to, and that I might be found by you as you don't desire, that perhaps there would be strife, jealousy, outbursts of anger, factions, slander, whisperings, proud thoughts, or riots,
21 that again when I come my God would humble me before you, and I would mourn for many of those who have sinned before now, and not repented of the uncleanness, sexual immorality, and lustfulness which they committed.

13

1 This is the third time I am coming to you. "At the mouth of two or three witnesses shall every word be established."*
2 I have warned previously, and I warn again, as when I was present the second time, so now, being absent, I write to those who have sinned before now and to all the rest that if I come again, I will not spare,
3 seeing that you seek a proof of Christ who speaks in me who is not weak, but is powerful in you.
4 For he was crucified through weakness, yet he lives through the power of God. For we also are weak in him, but we will live with him through the power of God toward you.
5 Examine your own selves, whether you are in the faith. Test your own selves. Or don't you know about your own selves, that Jesus Christ is in you?—unless indeed you are disqualified.
6 But I hope that you will know that we aren't disqualified.
7 Now I pray to God that you do no evil; not that we may appear approved, but that you may do that which is honorable, though we may seem to have failed.
8 For we can do nothing against the truth, but for the truth.
9 For we rejoice when we are weak and you are strong. We also pray for this: your becoming perfect.
10 For this cause I write these things while absent, that I may not deal sharply when present, according to the authority which the Lord gave me for building up and not for tearing down.
11 Finally, brothers, rejoice! Be perfected. Be comforted. Be of the same mind. Live in peace, and the God of love and peace will be with you.
12 Greet one another with a holy kiss.
13 All the saints greet you.
14 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, God's love, and the fellowship of the Holy Spirit be with you all. Amen.

* **13:1** Deuteronomy 19:15

Paul's Letter to the Galatians

1 Paul, an apostle—not from men, nor
through man, but through Jesus Christ,†
and God the Father, who raised him from
the dead—
2 and all the brothers‡ who are with me,
to the assemblies of Galatia:
3 Grace to you and peace from God the
Father and our Lord Jesus Christ,
4 who gave himself for our sins, that he
might deliver us out of this present evil
age, according to the will of our God and
Father—
5 to whom be the glory forever and ever.
Amen.
6 I marvel that you are so quickly
deserting him who called you in the grace
of Christ to a different "good news",
7 but there isn't another "good news."
Only there are some who trouble you and
want to pervert the Good News of Christ.
8 But even though we, or an angel from
heaven, should preach to you any "good
news" other than that which we preached
to you, let him be cursed.
9 As we have said before, so I now say
again: if any man preaches to you any
"good news" other than that which you
received, let him be cursed.
10 For am I now seeking the favor of
men, or of God? Or am I striving to please
men? For if I were still pleasing men, I
wouldn't be a servant of Christ.
11 But I make known to you, brothers,
concerning the Good News which was
preached by me, that it is not according to
man.
12 For I didn't receive it from man, nor
was I taught it, but it came to me through
revelation of Jesus Christ.
13 For you have heard of my way of
living in time past in the Jews' religion,
how that beyond measure I persecuted
the assembly of God and ravaged it.
14 I advanced in the Jews' religion
beyond many of my own age among my
countrymen, being more exceedingly
zealous for the traditions of my fathers.
15 But when it was the good pleasure of
God, who separated me from my mother's
womb and called me through his grace,
16 to reveal his Son in me, that I might
preach him among the Gentiles, I didn't
immediately confer with flesh and blood,
17 nor did I go up to Jerusalem to those
who were apostles before me, but I went
away into Arabia. Then I returned to
Damascus.
18 Then after three years I went up to
Jerusalem to visit Peter, and stayed with
him fifteen days.
19 But of the other apostles I saw no one
except James, the Lord's brother.
20 Now about the things which I write to
you, behold,§ before God, I'm not lying.
21 Then I came to the regions of Syria
and Cilicia.
22 I was still unknown by face to the
assemblies of Judea which were in Christ,
23 but they only heard, "He who once
persecuted us now preaches the faith that
he once tried to destroy."
24 So they glorified God in me.

2

1 Then after a period of fourteen years I
went up again to Jerusalem with
Barnabas, taking Titus also with me.
2 I went up by revelation, and I laid
before them the Good News which I
preach among the Gentiles, but privately
before those who were respected, for fear
that I might be running, or had run, in
vain.
3 But not even Titus, who was with me,
being a Greek, was compelled to be
circumcised.
4 This was because of the false brothers
secretly brought in, who stole in to spy out
our liberty which we have in Christ Jesus,
that they might bring us into bondage,

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:2** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." § **1:20** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

5 to whom we gave no place in the way
of subjection, not for an hour, that the
truth of the Good News might continue
with you.
6 But from those who were reputed to
be important—whatever they were, it
makes no difference to me; God doesn't
show partiality to man—they, I say, who
were respected imparted nothing to me,
7 but to the contrary, when they saw
that I had been entrusted with the Good
News for the uncircumcised, even as Peter
with the Good News for the circumcised—
8 for he who worked through Peter in
the apostleship with the circumcised also
worked through me with the Gentiles—
9 and when they perceived the grace
that was given to me, James and Cephas
and John, those who were reputed to be
pillars, gave to Barnabas and me the right
hand of fellowship, that we should go to
the Gentiles, and they to the circumcision.
10 They only asked us to remember the
poor—which very thing I was also zealous
to do.
11 But when Peter came to Antioch, I
resisted him to his face, because he stood
condemned.
12 For before some people came from
James, he ate with the Gentiles. But when
they came, he drew back and separated
himself, fearing those who were of the
circumcision.
13 And the rest of the Jews joined him in
his hypocrisy, so that even Barnabas was
carried away with their hypocrisy.
14 But when I saw that they didn't walk
uprightly according to the truth of the
Good News, I said to Peter before them all,
"If you, being a Jew, live as the Gentiles
do, and not as the Jews do, why do you
compel the Gentiles to live as the Jews do?
15 "We, being Jews by nature and not
Gentile sinners,
16 yet knowing that a man is not
justified by the works of the law but
through faith in Jesus Christ, even we
believed in Christ Jesus, that we might be
justified by faith in Christ and not by the
works of the law, because no flesh will be
justified by the works of the law.
17 But if while we sought to be justified
in Christ, we ourselves also were found
sinners, is Christ a servant of sin?
Certainly not!
18 For if I build up again those things
which I destroyed, I prove myself a
law-breaker.
19 For I through the law died to the law,
that I might live to God.
20 I have been crucified with Christ, and
it is no longer I who live, but Christ lives in
me. That life which I now live in the flesh,
I live by faith in the Son of God, who loved
me and gave himself up for me.
21 I don't reject the grace of God. For if
righteousness is through the law, then
Christ died for nothing!"

3

1 Foolish Galatians, who has bewitched
you not to obey the truth, before whose
eyes Jesus Christ was openly portrayed
among you as crucified?
2 I just want to learn this from you: Did
you receive the Spirit by the works of the
law, or by hearing of faith?
3 Are you so foolish? Having begun in
the Spirit, are you now completed in the
flesh?
4 Did you suffer so many things in vain,
if it is indeed in vain?
5 He therefore who supplies the Spirit to
you and does miracles among you, does
he do it by the works of the law, or by
hearing of faith?
6 Even so, Abraham "believed God, and
it was counted to him for righteousness."*
7 Know therefore that those who are of
faith are children of Abraham.
8 The Scripture, foreseeing that God
would justify the Gentiles by faith,
preached the Good News beforehand to
Abraham, saying, "In you all the nations
will be blessed."*
9 So then, those who are of faith are
blessed with the faithful Abraham.
10 For as many as are of the works of the
law are under a curse. For it is written,

* **3:6** Genesis 15:6 * **3:8** Genesis 12:3; 18:18; 22:18 * **3:10** Deuteronomy 27:26

"Cursed is everyone who doesn't continue
in all things that are written in the book of
the law, to do them."*
11 Now that no man is justified by the
law before God is evident, for, "The
righteous will live by faith."*
12 The law is not of faith, but, "The man
who does them will live by them."*
13 Christ redeemed us from the curse of
the law, having become a curse for us. For
it is written, "Cursed is everyone who
hangs on a tree,"*
14 that the blessing of Abraham might
come on the Gentiles through Christ Jesus,
that we might receive the promise of the
Spirit through faith.
15 Brothers, speaking of human terms,
though it is only a man's covenant, yet
when it has been confirmed, no one
makes it void or adds to it.
16 Now the promises were spoken to
Abraham and to his offspring.† He doesn't
say, "To descendants‡", as of many, but as
of one, "To your offspring",* which is
Christ.
17 Now I say this: A covenant confirmed
beforehand by God in Christ, the law,
which came four hundred thirty years
after, does not annul, so as to make the
promise of no effect.
18 For if the inheritance is of the law, it is
no more of promise; but God has granted
it to Abraham by promise.
19 Then why is there the law? It was
added because of transgressions, until the
offspring should come to whom the
promise has been made. It was ordained
through angels by the hand of a mediator.
20 Now a mediator is not between one,
but God is one.
21 Is the law then against the promises
of God? Certainly not! For if there had
been a law given which could make alive,
most certainly righteousness would have
been of the law.
22 But the Scripture imprisoned all
things under sin, that the promise by faith
in Jesus Christ might be given to those
who believe.
23 But before faith came, we were kept
in custody under the law, confined for the
faith which should afterwards be
revealed.
24 So that the law has become our tutor
to bring us to Christ, that we might be
justified by faith.
25 But now that faith has come, we are
no longer under a tutor.
26 For you are all children of God,
through faith in Christ Jesus.
27 For as many of you as were baptized
into Christ have put on Christ.
28 There is neither Jew nor Greek, there
is neither slave nor free man, there is
neither male nor female; for you are all
one in Christ Jesus.
29 If you are Christ's, then you are
Abraham's offspring and heirs according
to promise.

4

1 But I say that so long as the heir is a
child, he is no different from a
bondservant, though he is lord of all,
2 but is under guardians and stewards
until the day appointed by the father.
3 So we also, when we were children,
were held in bondage under the
elemental principles of the world.
4 But when the fullness of the time
came, God sent out his Son, born to a
woman, born under the law,
5 that he might redeem those who were
under the law, that we might receive the
adoption as children.
6 And because you are children, God
sent out the Spirit of his Son into your
hearts, crying, "Abba,† Father!"
7 So you are no longer a bondservant,
but a son; and if a son, then an heir of God
through Christ.
8 However at that time, not knowing
God, you were in bondage to those who by
nature are not gods.
9 But now that you have come to know
God, or rather to be known by God, why

* **3:11** Habakkuk 2:4 * **3:12** Leviticus 18:5 * **3:13** Deuteronomy 21:23 † **3:16** or, seed ‡ **3:16** or, seeds
* **3:16** Genesis 12:7; 13:15; 24:7 † **4:6** Abba is a Greek spelling for the Aramaic word for "Father" or "Daddy" used in a familiar, respectful, and loving way.

do you turn back again to the weak and
miserable elemental principles, to which
you desire to be in bondage all over again?
10 You observe days, months, seasons,
and years.
11 I am afraid for you, that I might have
wasted my labor for you.
12 I beg you, brothers, become as I am,
for I also have become as you are. You did
me no wrong,
13 but you know that because of
weakness in the flesh I preached the Good
News to you the first time.
14 That which was a temptation to you
in my flesh, you didn't despise nor reject;
but you received me as an angel of God,
even as Christ Jesus.
15 What was the blessing you enjoyed?
For I testify to you that, if possible, you
would have plucked out your eyes and
given them to me.
16 So then, have I become your enemy
by telling you the truth?
17 They zealously seek you in no good
way. No, they desire to alienate you, that
you may seek them.
18 But it is always good to be zealous in a
good cause, and not only when I am
present with you.
19 My little children, of whom I am again
in travail until Christ is formed in you—
20 but I could wish to be present with
you now, and to change my tone, for I am
perplexed about you.
21 Tell me, you that desire to be under
the law, don't you listen to the law?
22 For it is written that Abraham had
two sons, one by the servant, and one by
the free woman.
23 However, the son by the servant was
born according to the flesh, but the son by
the free woman was born through
promise.
24 These things contain an allegory, for
these are two covenants. One is from
Mount Sinai, bearing children to bondage,
which is Hagar.
25 For this Hagar is Mount Sinai in
Arabia, and answers to the Jerusalem that
exists now, for she is in bondage with her
children.
26 But the Jerusalem that is above is
free, which is the mother of us all.
27 For it is written,
"Rejoice, you barren who don't bear.
Break out and shout, you who don't
travail.
For the desolate women have more
children than her who has a
husband."*
28 Now we, brothers, as Isaac was, are
children of promise.
29 But as then, he who was born
according to the flesh persecuted him
who was born according to the Spirit, so
also it is now.
30 However, what does the Scripture
say? "Throw out the servant and her son,
for the son of the servant will not inherit
with the son of the free woman."*
31 So then, brothers, we are not children
of a servant, but of the free woman.

5

1 Stand firm therefore in the liberty by
which Christ has made us free, and don't
be entangled again with a yoke of
bondage.
2 Behold, I, Paul, tell you that if you
receive circumcision, Christ will profit
you nothing.
3 Yes, I testify again to every man who
receives circumcision that he is a debtor
to do the whole law.
4 You are alienated from Christ, you
who desire to be justified by the law. You
have fallen away from grace.
5 For we through the Spirit, by faith wait
for the hope of righteousness.
6 For in Christ Jesus neither
circumcision nor uncircumcision
amounts to anything, but faith working
through love.
7 You were running well! Who
interfered with you that you should not
obey the truth?
8 This persuasion is not from him who
calls you.
9 A little yeast grows through the whole
lump.

* **4:27** Isaiah 54:1 * **4:30** Genesis 21:10

10 I have confidence toward you in the
Lord that you will think no other way. But
he who troubles you will bear his
judgment, whoever he is.
11 But I, brothers, if I still preach
circumcision, why am I still persecuted?
Then the stumbling block of the cross has
been removed.
12 I wish that those who disturb you
would cut themselves off.
13 For you, brothers, were called for
freedom. Only don't use your freedom as
an opportunity for the flesh, but through
love be servants to one another.
14 For the whole law is fulfilled in one
word, in this: "You shall love your
neighbor as yourself."*
15 But if you bite and devour one
another, be careful that you don't
consume one another.
16 But I say, walk by the Spirit, and you
won't fulfill the lust of the flesh.
17 For the flesh lusts against the Spirit,
and the Spirit against the flesh; and these
are contrary to one another, that you may
not do the things that you desire.
18 But if you are led by the Spirit, you
are not under the law.
19 Now the deeds of the flesh are
obvious, which are: adultery, sexual
immorality, uncleanness, lustfulness,
20 idolatry, sorcery, hatred, strife,
jealousies, outbursts of anger, rivalries,
divisions, heresies,
21 envy, murders, drunkenness, orgies,
and things like these; of which I forewarn
you, even as I also forewarned you, that
those who practice such things will not
inherit God's Kingdom.
22 But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy,
peace, patience, kindness, goodness,
faith,†
23 gentleness, and self-control. Against
such things there is no law.
24 Those who belong to Christ have
crucified the flesh with its passions and
lusts.
25 If we live by the Spirit, let's also walk
by the Spirit.
26 Let's not become conceited,
provoking one another, and envying one
another.

6

1 Brothers, even if a man is caught in
some fault, you who are spiritual must
restore such a one in a spirit of gentleness,
looking to yourself so that you also aren't
tempted.
2 Bear one another's burdens, and so
fulfill the law of Christ.
3 For if a man thinks himself to be
something when he is nothing, he
deceives himself.
4 But let each man examine his own
work, and then he will have reason to
boast in himself, and not in someone else.
5 For each man will bear his own
burden.
6 But let him who is taught in the word
share all good things with him who
teaches.
7 Don't be deceived. God is not mocked,
for whatever a man sows, that he will also
reap.
8 For he who sows to his own flesh will
from the flesh reap corruption. But he
who sows to the Spirit will from the Spirit
reap eternal life.
9 Let's not be weary in doing good, for
we will reap in due season if we don't give
up.
10 So then, as we have opportunity, let's
do what is good toward all men, and
especially toward those who are of the
household of the faith.
11 See with what large letters I write to
you with my own hand.
12 As many as desire to make a good
impression in the flesh compel you to be
circumcised, just so they may not be
persecuted for the cross of Christ.
13 For even they who receive
circumcision don't keep the law
themselves, but they desire to have you
circumcised, so that they may boast in
your flesh.
14 But far be it from me to boast except
in the cross of our Lord Jesus Christ,
through which the world has been
crucified to me, and I to the world.

* **5:14** Leviticus 19:18 † **5:22** or, faithfulness

15 For in Christ Jesus neither is
circumcision anything, nor
uncircumcision, but a new creation.
16 As many as walk by this rule, peace
and mercy be on them, and on God's
Israel.
17 From now on, let no one cause me
any trouble, for I bear the marks of the
Lord Jesus branded on my body.
18 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be
with your spirit, brothers. Amen.

Paul's Letter to the Ephesians

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ† Jesus
through the will of God, to the saints who
are at Ephesus, and the faithful in Christ
Jesus:
2 Grace to you and peace from God our
Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.
3 Blessed be the God and Father of our
Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed us with
every spiritual blessing in the heavenly
places in Christ,
4 even as he chose us in him before the
foundation of the world, that we would be
holy and without defect before him in
love,
5 having predestined us for adoption as
children through Jesus Christ to himself,
according to the good pleasure of his
desire,
6 to the praise of the glory of his grace,
by which he freely gave us favor in the
Beloved.
7 In him we have our redemption
through his blood, the forgiveness of our
trespasses, according to the riches of his
grace
8 which he made to abound toward us in
all wisdom and prudence,
9 making known to us the mystery of his
will, according to his good pleasure which
he purposed in him
10 to an administration of the fullness of
the times, to sum up all things in Christ,
the things in the heavens and the things
on the earth, in him.
11 We were also assigned an inheritance
in him, having been foreordained
according to the purpose of him who does
all things after the counsel of his will,
12 to the end that we should be to the
praise of his glory, we who had before
hoped in Christ.
13 In him you also, having heard the
word of the truth, the Good News of your
salvation—in whom, having also believed,
you were sealed with the promised Holy
Spirit,
14 who is a pledge of our inheritance, to
the redemption of God's own possession,
to the praise of his glory.
15 For this cause I also, having heard of
the faith in the Lord Jesus which is among
you and the love which you have toward
all the saints,
16 don't cease to give thanks for you,
making mention of you in my prayers,
17 that the God of our Lord Jesus Christ,
the Father of glory, may give to you a
spirit of wisdom and revelation in the
knowledge of him,
18 having the eyes of your hearts‡
enlightened, that you may know what is
the hope of his calling, and what are the
riches of the glory of his inheritance in the
saints,
19 and what is the exceeding greatness
of his power toward us who believe,
according to that working of the strength
of his might
20 which he worked in Christ when he
raised him from the dead and made him
to sit at his right hand in the heavenly
places,
21 far above all rule, authority, power,
dominion, and every name that is named,
not only in this age, but also in that which
is to come.
22 He put all things in subjection under
his feet, and gave him to be head over all
things for the assembly,
23 which is his body, the fullness of him
who fills all in all.

2

1 You were made alive when you were
dead in transgressions and sins,
2 in which you once walked according to
the course of this world, according to the
prince of the power of the air, the spirit
who now works in the children of
disobedience.
3 We also all once lived among them in
the lusts of our flesh, doing the desires of
the flesh and of the mind, and were by
nature children of wrath, even as the rest.

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:18** TR reads "understanding" instead of "hearts"

4 But God, being rich in mercy, for his
great love with which he loved us,
5 even when we were dead through our
trespasses, made us alive together with
Christ—by grace you have been saved—
6 and raised us up with him, and made
us to sit with him in the heavenly places in
Christ Jesus,
7 that in the ages to come he might show
the exceeding riches of his grace in
kindness toward us in Christ Jesus;
8 for by grace you have been saved
through faith, and that not of yourselves;
it is the gift of God,
9 not of works, that no one would boast.
10 For we are his workmanship, created
in Christ Jesus for good works, which God
prepared before that we would walk in
them.
11 Therefore remember that once you,
the Gentiles in the flesh, who are called
“uncircumcision” by that which is called
“circumcision” (in the flesh, made by
hands),
12 that you were at that time separate
from Christ, alienated from the
commonwealth of Israel, and strangers
from the covenants of the promise, having
no hope and without God in the world.
13 But now in Christ Jesus you who once
were far off are made near in the blood of
Christ.
14 For he is our peace, who made both
one, and broke down the middle wall of
separation,
15 having abolished in his flesh the
hostility, the law of commandments
contained in ordinances, that he might
create in himself one new man of the two,
making peace,
16 and might reconcile them both in one
body to God through the cross, having
killed the hostility through it.
17 He came and preached peace to you
who were far off and to those who were
near.
18 For through him we both have our
access in one Spirit to the Father.
19 So then you are no longer strangers
and foreigners, but you are fellow citizens
with the saints and of the household of
God,
20 being built on the foundation of the
apostles and prophets, Christ Jesus
himself being the chief cornerstone;
21 in whom the whole building, fitted
together, grows into a holy temple in the
Lord;
22 in whom you also are built together
for a habitation of God in the Spirit.

3

1 For this cause I, Paul, am the prisoner
of Christ Jesus on behalf of you Gentiles,
2 if it is so that you have heard of the
administration of that grace of God which
was given me toward you,
3 how that by revelation the mystery
was made known to me, as I wrote before
in few words,
4 by which, when you read, you can
perceive my understanding in the
mystery of Christ,
5 which in other generations was not
made known to the children of men, as it
has now been revealed to his holy
apostles and prophets in the Spirit,
6 that the Gentiles are fellow heirs and
fellow members of the body, and fellow
partakers of his promise in Christ Jesus
through the Good News,
7 of which I was made a servant
according to the gift of that grace of God
which was given me according to the
working of his power.
8 To me, the very least of all saints, was
this grace given, to preach to the Gentiles
the unsearchable riches of Christ,
9 and to make all men see what is the
administration† of the mystery which for
ages has been hidden in God, who created
all things through Jesus Christ,
10 to the intent that now through the
assembly the manifold wisdom of God
might be made known to the principalities
and the powers in the heavenly places,
11 according to the eternal purpose
which he accomplished in Christ Jesus our
Lord.

† **3:9** TR reads “fellowship” instead of “administration”

12 In him we have boldness and access
in confidence through our faith in him.
13 Therefore I ask that you may not lose
heart at my troubles for you, which are
your glory.
14 For this cause, I bow my knees to the
Father of our Lord Jesus Christ,
15 from whom every family in heaven
and on earth is named,
16 that he would grant you, according to
the riches of his glory, that you may be
strengthened with power through his
Spirit in the inner person,
17 that Christ may dwell in your hearts
through faith, to the end that you, being
rooted and grounded in love,
18 may be strengthened to comprehend
with all the saints what is the width and
length and height and depth,
19 and to know Christ's love which
surpasses knowledge, that you may be
filled with all the fullness of God.
20 Now to him who is able to do
exceedingly abundantly above all that we
ask or think, according to the power that
works in us,
21 to him be the glory in the assembly
and in Christ Jesus to all generations,
forever and ever. Amen.

4

1 I therefore, the prisoner in the Lord,
beg you to walk worthily of the calling
with which you were called,
2 with all lowliness and humility, with
patience, bearing with one another in
love,
3 being eager to keep the unity of the
Spirit in the bond of peace.
4 There is one body and one Spirit, even
as you also were called in one hope of
your calling,
5 one Lord, one faith, one baptism,
6 one God and Father of all, who is over
all and through all and in us all.
7 But to each one of us, the grace was
given according to the measure of the gift
of Christ.
8 Therefore he says,
"When he ascended on high,
he led captivity captive,
and gave gifts to people."*
9 Now this, "He ascended", what is it but
that he also first descended into the lower
parts of the earth?
10 He who descended is the one who also
ascended far above all the heavens, that
he might fill all things.

11 He gave some to be apostles; and
some, prophets; and some, evangelists;
and some, shepherds† and teachers;
12 for the perfecting of the saints, to the
work of serving, to the building up of the
body of Christ,
13 until we all attain to the unity of the
faith and of the knowledge of the Son of
God, to a full grown man, to the measure
of the stature of the fullness of Christ,
14 that we may no longer be children,
tossed back and forth and carried about
with every wind of doctrine, by the
trickery of men, in craftiness, after the
wiles of error;
15 but speaking truth in love, we may
grow up in all things into him who is the
head, Christ,
16 from whom all the body, being fitted
and knit together through that which
every joint supplies, according to the
working in measure of each individual
part, makes the body increase to the
building up of itself in love.

17 This I say therefore, and testify in the
Lord, that you no longer walk as the rest
of the Gentiles also walk, in the futility of
their mind,
18 being darkened in their
understanding, alienated from the life of
God because of the ignorance that is in
them, because of the hardening of their
hearts.
19 They, having become callous, gave
themselves up to lust, to work all
uncleanness with greediness.
20 But you didn't learn Christ that way,
21 if indeed you heard him and were
taught in him, even as truth is in Jesus:
22 that you put away, as concerning
your former way of life, the old man that
grows corrupt after the lusts of deceit,

* **4:8** Psalms 68:18 † **4:11** or, pastors

23 and that you be renewed in the spirit
of your mind,
24 and put on the new man, who in the
likeness of God has been created in
righteousness and holiness of truth.
25 Therefore, putting away falsehood,
speak truth each one with his neighbor,
for we are members of one another.
26 "Be angry, and don't sin."* Don't let
the sun go down on your wrath,
27 and don't give place‡ to the devil.
28 Let him who stole steal no more; but
rather let him labor, producing with his
hands something that is good, that he may
have something to give to him who has
need.
29 Let no corrupt speech proceed out of
your mouth, but only what is good for
building others up as the need may be,
that it may give grace to those who hear.
30 Don't grieve the Holy Spirit of God, in
whom you were sealed for the day of
redemption.
31 Let all bitterness, wrath, anger,
outcry, and slander be put away from
you, with all malice.
32 And be kind to one another, tender
hearted, forgiving each other, just as God
also in Christ forgave you.

5

1 Be therefore imitators of God, as
beloved children.
2 Walk in love, even as Christ also loved
us and gave himself up for us, an offering
and a sacrifice to God for a sweet-smelling
fragrance.
3 But sexual immorality, and all
uncleanness or covetousness, let it not
even be mentioned among you, as
becomes saints;
4 nor filthiness, nor foolish talking, nor
jesting, which are not appropriate, but
rather giving of thanks.
5 Know this for sure, that no sexually
immoral person, nor unclean person, nor
covetous man (who is an idolater), has
any inheritance in the Kingdom of Christ
and God.
6 Let no one deceive you with empty
words, for because of these things the
wrath of God comes on the children of
disobedience.
7 Therefore don't be partakers with
them.
8 For you were once darkness, but are
now light in the Lord. Walk as children of
light,
9 for the fruit of the Spirit is in all
goodness and righteousness and truth,
10 proving what is well pleasing to the
Lord.
11 Have no fellowship with the
unfruitful deeds of darkness, but rather
even reprove them.
12 For it is a shame even to speak of the
things which are done by them in secret.
13 But all things, when they are
reproved, are revealed by the light, for
everything that reveals is light.
14 Therefore he says, "Awake, you who
sleep, and arise from the dead, and Christ
will shine on you."

15 Therefore watch carefully how you
walk, not as unwise, but as wise,
16 redeeming the time, because the days
are evil.
17 Therefore, don't be foolish, but
understand what the will of the Lord is.
18 Don't be drunken with wine, in which
is dissipation, but be filled with the Spirit,
19 speaking to one another in psalms,
hymns, and spiritual songs; singing and
making melody in your heart to the Lord;
20 giving thanks always concerning all
things in the name of our Lord Jesus
Christ to God, even the Father;
21 subjecting yourselves to one another
in the fear of Christ.

22 Wives, be subject to your own
husbands, as to the Lord.
23 For the husband is the head of the
wife, as Christ also is the head of the
assembly, being himself the savior of the
body.
24 But as the assembly is subject to
Christ, so let the wives also be to their own
husbands in everything.

* **4:26** Psalms 4:4 ‡ **4:27** or, opportunity

25 Husbands, love your wives, even as
Christ also loved the assembly and gave
himself up for her,
26 that he might sanctify her, having
cleansed her by the washing of water with
the word,
27 that he might present the assembly to
himself gloriously, not having spot or
wrinkle or any such thing, but that she
should be holy and without defect.
28 Even so husbands also ought to love
their own wives as their own bodies. He
who loves his own wife loves himself.
29 For no man ever hated his own flesh,
but nourishes and cherishes it, even as
the Lord also does the assembly,
30 because we are members of his body,
of his flesh and bones.
31 "For this cause a man will leave his
father and mother and will be joined to
his wife. Then the two will become one
flesh."*
32 This mystery is great, but I speak
concerning Christ and the assembly.
33 Nevertheless each of you must also
love his own wife even as himself; and let
the wife see that she respects her
husband.

6

1 Children, obey your parents in the
Lord, for this is right.
2 "Honor your father and mother,"
which is the first commandment with a
promise:
3 "that it may be well with you, and you
may live long on the earth."*
4 You fathers, don't provoke your
children to wrath, but nurture them in the
discipline and instruction of the Lord.
5 Servants, be obedient to those who
according to the flesh are your masters,
with fear and trembling, in singleness of
your heart, as to Christ,
6 not in the way of service only when
eyes are on you, as men pleasers, but as
servants of Christ, doing the will of God
from the heart,
7 with good will doing service as to the
Lord and not to men,
8 knowing that whatever good thing
each one does, he will receive the same
good again from the Lord, whether he is
bound or free.
9 You masters, do the same things to
them, and give up threatening, knowing
that he who is both their Master and
yours is in heaven, and there is no
partiality with him.
10 Finally, be strong in the Lord and in
the strength of his might.
11 Put on the whole armor of God, that
you may be able to stand against the wiles
of the devil.
12 For our wrestling is not against flesh
and blood, but against the principalities,
against the powers, against the world's
rulers of the darkness of this age, and
against the spiritual forces of wickedness
in the heavenly places.
13 Therefore put on the whole armor of
God, that you may be able to withstand in
the evil day, and having done all, to stand.
14 Stand therefore, having the utility
belt of truth buckled around your waist,
and having put on the breastplate of
righteousness,
15 and having fitted your feet with the
preparation of the Good News of peace,
16 above all, taking up the shield of faith,
with which you will be able to quench all
the fiery darts of the evil one.
17 And take the helmet of salvation, and
the sword of the Spirit, which is the word†
of God;
18 with all prayer and requests, praying
at all times in the Spirit, and being
watchful to this end in all perseverance
and requests for all the saints.
19 Pray for me, that utterance may be
given to me in opening my mouth, to
make known with boldness the mystery of
the Good News,
20 for which I am an ambassador in
chains; that in it I may speak boldly, as I
ought to speak.
21 But that you also may know my
affairs, how I am doing, Tychicus, the
beloved brother and faithful servant in

* **5:31** Genesis 2:24 * **6:3** Deuteronomy 5:16 † **6:17** from the Greek "ῥῆμα" (rhema), which means "spoken word"

the Lord, will make known to you all
things.
22 I have sent him to you for this very
purpose, that you may know our state and
that he may comfort your hearts.
23 Peace be to the brothers, and love
with faith, from God the Father and the
Lord Jesus Christ.
24 Grace be with all those who love our
Lord Jesus Christ with incorruptible love.
Amen.

Paul's Letter to the Philippians

1 Paul and Timothy, servants of Jesus Christ,† to all the saints in Christ Jesus who are at Philippi, with the overseers‡ and servants:§
2 Grace to you and peace from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.
3 I thank my God whenever I remember you,
4 always in every request of mine on behalf of you all, making my requests with joy,
5 for your partnership† in furtherance of the Good News from the first day until now;
6 being confident of this very thing, that he who began a good work in you will complete it until the day of Jesus Christ.
7 It is even right for me to think this way on behalf of all of you, because I have you in my heart, because both in my bonds and in the defense and confirmation of the Good News, you all are partakers with me of grace.
8 For God is my witness, how I long after all of you in the tender mercies of Christ Jesus.
9 This I pray, that your love may abound yet more and more in knowledge and all discernment,
10 so that you may approve the things that are excellent, that you may be sincere and without offense to the day of Christ,
11 being filled with the fruits of righteousness which are through Jesus Christ, to the glory and praise of God.
12 Now I desire to have you know, brothers,‡ that the things which happened to me have turned out rather to the progress of the Good News,
13 so that it became evident to the whole palace§ guard, and to all the rest, that my bonds are in Christ,
14 and that most of the brothers in the Lord, being confident through my bonds, are more abundantly bold to speak the word of God without fear.
15 Some indeed preach Christ even out of envy and strife, and some also out of good will.
16 The former insincerely preach Christ from selfish ambition, thinking that they add affliction to my chains;
17 but the latter out of love, knowing that I am appointed for the defense of the Good News.
18 What does it matter? Only that in every way, whether in pretense or in truth, Christ is proclaimed. I rejoice in this, yes, and will rejoice.
19 For I know that this will turn out to my salvation through your prayers and the supply of the Spirit of Jesus Christ,
20 according to my earnest expectation and hope, that I will in no way be disappointed, but with all boldness, as always, now also Christ will be magnified in my body, whether by life or by death.
21 For to me to live is Christ, and to die is gain.
22 But if I live on in the flesh, this will bring fruit from my work; yet I don't know what I will choose.
23 But I am hard pressed between the two, having the desire to depart and be with Christ, which is far better.
24 Yet to remain in the flesh is more needful for your sake.
25 Having this confidence, I know that I will remain, yes, and remain with you all for your progress and joy in the faith,
26 that your boasting† may abound in Christ Jesus in me through my presence with you again.
27 Only let your way of life be worthy of the Good News of Christ, that whether I come and see you or am absent, I may hear of your state, that you stand firm in one spirit, with one soul striving for the faith of the Good News;

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:1** or, superintendents, or bishops § **1:1** Or, deacons † **1:5** The word translated "partnership" (κοινωνία) also means "fellowship" and "sharing". ‡ **1:12** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." § **1:13** or, praetorian † **1:26** or, rejoicing

28 and in nothing frightened by the
adversaries, which is for them a proof of
destruction, but to you of salvation, and
that from God.
29 Because it has been granted to you on
behalf of Christ, not only to believe in
him, but also to suffer on his behalf,
30 having the same conflict which you
saw in me and now hear is in me.

2

1 If therefore there is any exhortation in
Christ, if any consolation of love, if any
fellowship of the Spirit, if any tender
mercies and compassion,
2 make my joy full by being like-minded,
having the same love, being of one accord,
of one mind;
3 doing nothing through rivalry or
through conceit, but in humility, each
counting others better than himself;
4 each of you not just looking to his own
things, but each of you also to the things of
others.
5 Have this in your mind, which was
also in Christ Jesus,
6 who, existing in the form of God, didn't
consider equality with God a thing to be
grasped,
7 but emptied himself, taking the form
of a servant, being made in the likeness of
men.
8 And being found in human form, he
humbled himself, becoming obedient to
the point of death, yes, the death of the
cross.
9 Therefore God also highly exalted him,
and gave to him the name which is above
every name,
10 that at the name of Jesus every knee
should bow, of those in heaven, those on
earth, and those under the earth,
11 and that every tongue should confess
that Jesus Christ is Lord, to the glory of
God the Father.
12 So then, my beloved, even as you
have always obeyed, not only in my
presence, but now much more in my
absence, work out your own salvation
with fear and trembling.
13 For it is God who works in you both to
will and to work for his good pleasure.
14 Do all things without complaining
and arguing,
15 that you may become blameless and
harmless, children of God without defect
in the middle of a crooked and perverse
generation, among whom you are seen as
lights in the world,
16 holding up the word of life, that I may
have something to boast in the day of
Christ that I didn't run in vain nor labor in
vain.
17 Yes, and if I am poured out on the
sacrifice and service of your faith, I am
glad and rejoice with you all.
18 In the same way, you also should be
glad and rejoice with me.
19 But I hope in the Lord Jesus to send
Timothy to you soon, that I also may be
cheered up when I know how you are
doing.
20 For I have no one else like-minded,
who will truly care about you.
21 For they all seek their own, not the
things of Jesus Christ.
22 But you know that he has proved
himself. As a child serves a father, so he
served with me in furtherance of the
Good News.
23 Therefore I hope to send him at once,
as soon as I see how it will go with me.
24 But I trust in the Lord that I myself
also will come shortly.
25 But I thought it necessary to send to
you Epaphroditus, my brother, fellow
worker, fellow soldier, and your apostle
and servant of my need,
26 since he longed for you all, and was
very troubled because you had heard that
he was sick.
27 For indeed he was sick nearly to
death, but God had mercy on him, and not
on him only, but on me also, that I might
not have sorrow on sorrow.
28 I have sent him therefore the more
diligently, that when you see him again,
you may rejoice, and that I may be the less
sorrowful.
29 Receive him therefore in the Lord
with all joy, and hold such people in
honor,
30 because for the work of Christ he
came near to death, risking his life to

supply that which was lacking in your service toward me.

3

1 Finally, my brothers, rejoice in the Lord! To write the same things to you, to me indeed is not tiresome, but for you it is safe.
2 Beware of the dogs; beware of the evil workers; beware of the false circumcision.
3 For we are the circumcision, who worship God in the Spirit, and rejoice in Christ Jesus, and have no confidence in the flesh;
4 though I myself might have confidence even in the flesh. If any other man thinks that he has confidence in the flesh, I yet more:
5 circumcised the eighth day, of the stock of Israel, of the tribe of Benjamin, a Hebrew of Hebrews; concerning the law, a Pharisee;
6 concerning zeal, persecuting the assembly; concerning the righteousness which is in the law, found blameless.
7 However, I consider those things that were gain to me as a loss for Christ.
8 Yes most certainly, and I count all things to be a loss for the excellency of the knowledge of Christ Jesus, my Lord, for whom I suffered the loss of all things, and count them nothing but refuse, that I may gain Christ
9 and be found in him, not having a righteousness of my own, that which is of the law, but that which is through faith in Christ, the righteousness which is from God by faith,
10 that I may know him and the power of his resurrection, and the fellowship of his sufferings, becoming conformed to his death,
11 if by any means I may attain to the resurrection from the dead.
12 Not that I have already obtained, or am already made perfect; but I press on, that I may take hold of that for which also I was taken hold of by Christ Jesus.
13 Brothers, I don't regard myself as yet having taken hold, but one thing I do: forgetting the things which are behind and stretching forward to the things which are before,
14 I press on toward the goal for the prize of the high calling of God in Christ Jesus.
15 Let us therefore, as many as are perfect, think this way. If in anything you think otherwise, God will also reveal that to you.
16 Nevertheless, to the extent that we have already attained, let's walk by the same rule. Let's be of the same mind.
17 Brothers, be imitators together of me, and note those who walk this way, even as you have us for an example.
18 For many walk, of whom I told you often, and now tell you even weeping, as the enemies of the cross of Christ,
19 whose end is destruction, whose god is the belly, and whose glory is in their shame, who think about earthly things.
20 For our citizenship is in heaven, from where we also wait for a Savior, the Lord Jesus Christ,
21 who will change the body of our humiliation to be conformed to the body of his glory, according to the working by which he is able even to subject all things to himself.

4

1 Therefore, my brothers, beloved and longed for, my joy and crown, stand firm in the Lord in this way, my beloved.
2 I exhort Euodia, and I exhort Syntyche, to think the same way in the Lord.
3 Yes, I beg you also, true partner, help these women, for they labored with me in the Good News with Clement also, and the rest of my fellow workers, whose names are in the book of life.
4 Rejoice in the Lord always! Again I will say, "Rejoice!"
5 Let your gentleness be known to all men. The Lord is at hand.
6 In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God.
7 And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your thoughts in Christ Jesus.

8 Finally, brothers, whatever things are
true, whatever things are honorable,
whatever things are just, whatever things
are pure, whatever things are lovely,
whatever things are of good report: if
there is any virtue and if there is anything
worthy of praise, think about these things.
9 Do the things which you learned,
received, heard, and saw in me, and the
God of peace will be with you.
10 But I rejoice in the Lord greatly that
now at length you have revived your
thought for me; in which you did indeed
take thought, but you lacked opportunity.
11 Not that I speak because of lack, for I
have learned in whatever state I am, to be
content in it.
12 I know how to be humbled, and I also
know how to abound. In any and all
circumstances I have learned the secret
both to be filled and to be hungry, both to
abound and to be in need.
13 I can do all things through Christ who
strengthens me.
14 However you did well that you
shared in my affliction.
15 You yourselves also know, you
Philippians, that in the beginning of the
Good News, when I departed from
Macedonia, no assembly shared with me
in the matter of giving and receiving but
you only.
16 For even in Thessalonica you sent
once and again to my need.
17 Not that I seek for the gift, but I seek
for the fruit that increases to your
account.
18 But I have all things and abound. I am
filled, having received from Epaphroditus
the things that came from you, a
sweet-smelling fragrance, an acceptable
and well-pleasing sacrifice to God.
19 My God will supply every need of
yours according to his riches in glory in
Christ Jesus.
20 Now to our God and Father be the
glory forever and ever! Amen.
21 Greet every saint in Christ Jesus. The
brothers who are with me greet you.
22 All the saints greet you, especially
those who are of Caesar's household.
23 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be
with you all. Amen.

Paul's Letter to the Colossians

1 Paul, an apostle of Christ† Jesus
through the will of God, and Timothy our
brother,
2 to the saints and faithful brothers‡ in
Christ at Colossae: Grace to you and peace
from God our Father and the Lord Jesus
Christ.
3 We give thanks to God the Father of
our Lord Jesus Christ, praying always for
you,
4 having heard of your faith in Christ
Jesus and of the love which you have
toward all the saints,
5 because of the hope which is laid up
for you in the heavens, of which you
heard before in the word of the truth of
the Good News
6 which has come to you, even as it is in
all the world and is bearing fruit and
growing, as it does in you also, since the
day you heard and knew the grace of God
in truth,
7 even as you learned from Epaphras
our beloved fellow servant, who is a
faithful servant of Christ on your§ behalf,
8 who also declared to us your love in
the Spirit.

9 For this cause, we also, since the day
we heard this, don't cease praying and
making requests for you, that you may be
filled with the knowledge of his will in all
spiritual wisdom and understanding,
10 that you may walk worthily of the
Lord, to please him in all respects, bearing
fruit in every good work and increasing in
the knowledge of God,
11 strengthened with all power,
according to the might of his glory, for all
endurance and perseverance with joy,
12 giving thanks to the Father, who
made us fit to be partakers of the
inheritance of the saints in light,
13 who delivered us out of the power of
darkness, and translated us into the
Kingdom of the Son of his love,
14 in whom we have our redemption,†
the forgiveness of our sins.

15 He is the image of the invisible God,
the firstborn of all creation.
16 For by him all things were created in
the heavens and on the earth, visible
things and invisible things, whether
thrones or dominions or principalities or
powers. All things have been created
through him and for him.
17 He is before all things, and in him all
things are held together.
18 He is the head of the body, the
assembly, who is the beginning, the
firstborn from the dead, that in all things
he might have the preeminence.
19 For all the fullness was pleased to
dwell in him,
20 and through him to reconcile all
things to himself by him, whether things
on the earth or things in the heavens,
having made peace through the blood of
his cross.

21 You, being in past times alienated and
enemies in your mind in your evil deeds,
22 yet now he has reconciled in the body
of his flesh through death, to present you
holy and without defect and blameless
before him,
23 if it is so that you continue in the
faith, grounded and steadfast, and not
moved away from the hope of the Good
News which you heard, which was
proclaimed in all creation under heaven,
of which I, Paul, was made a servant.

24 Now I rejoice in my sufferings for
your sake, and fill up on my part that
which is lacking of the afflictions of Christ
in my flesh for his body's sake, which is
the assembly,
25 of which I was made a servant
according to the stewardship of God
which was given me toward you to fulfill
the word of God,

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:2** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." § **1:7** NU reads *our* † **1:14** TR adds "through his blood,"

26 the mystery which has been hidden
for ages and generations. But now it has
been revealed to his saints,
27 to whom God was pleased to make
known what are the riches of the glory of
this mystery among the Gentiles, which is
Christ in you, the hope of glory.
28 We proclaim him, admonishing every
man and teaching every man in all
wisdom, that we may present every man
perfect in Christ Jesus;
29 for which I also labor, striving
according to his working, which works in
me mightily.

2

1 For I desire to have you know how
greatly I struggle for you and for those at
Laodicea, and for as many as have not
seen my face in the flesh;
2 that their hearts may be comforted,
they being knit together in love, and
gaining all riches of the full assurance of
understanding, that they may know the
mystery of God, both of the Father and of
Christ,
3 in whom all the treasures of wisdom
and knowledge are hidden.
4 Now I say this that no one may delude
you with persuasiveness of speech.
5 For though I am absent in the flesh, yet
I am with you in the spirit, rejoicing and
seeing your order, and the steadfastness
of your faith in Christ.
6 As therefore you received Christ Jesus
the Lord, walk in him,
7 rooted and built up in him and
established in the faith, even as you were
taught, abounding in it in thanksgiving.
8 Be careful that you don't let anyone
rob you through his philosophy and vain
deceit, after the tradition of men, after the
elemental spirits of the world, and not
after Christ.
9 For in him all the fullness of the Deity
dwells bodily,
10 and in him you are made full, who is
the head of all principality and power.
11 In him you were also circumcised
with a circumcision not made with hands,
in the putting off of the body of the sins of
the flesh, in the circumcision of Christ,
12 having been buried with him in
baptism, in which you were also raised
with him through faith in the working of
God, who raised him from the dead.
13 You were dead through your
trespasses and the uncircumcision of your
flesh. He made you alive together with
him, having forgiven us all our trespasses,
14 wiping out the handwriting in
ordinances which was against us. He has
taken it out of the way, nailing it to the
cross.
15 Having stripped the principalities
and the powers, he made a show of them
openly, triumphing over them in it.
16 Let no one therefore judge you in
eating or drinking, or with respect to a
feast day or a new moon or a Sabbath day,
17 which are a shadow of the things to
come; but the body is Christ's.
18 Let no one rob you of your prize by
self-abasement and worshiping of the
angels, dwelling in the things which he
has not seen, vainly puffed up by his
fleshly mind,
19 and not holding firmly to the Head,
from whom all the body, being supplied
and knit together through the joints and
ligaments, grows with God's growth.
20 If you died with Christ from the
elemental spirits of the world, why, as
though living in the world, do you subject
yourselves to ordinances,
21 "Don't handle, nor taste, nor touch"
22 (all of which perish with use),
according to the precepts and doctrines of
men?
23 These things indeed appear like
wisdom in self-imposed worship,
humility, and severity to the body, but
aren't of any value against the indulgence
of the flesh.

3

1 If then you were raised together with
Christ, seek the things that are above,
where Christ is, seated on the right hand
of God.

2 Set your mind on the things that are above, not on the things that are on the earth.
3 For you died, and your life is hidden with Christ in God.
4 When Christ, our life, is revealed, then you will also be revealed with him in glory.
5 Put to death therefore your members which are on the earth: sexual immorality, uncleanness, depraved passion, evil desire, and covetousness, which is idolatry.
6 For these things' sake the wrath of God comes on the children of disobedience.
7 You also once walked in those, when you lived in them,
8 but now you must put them all away: anger, wrath, malice, slander, and shameful speaking out of your mouth.
9 Don't lie to one another, seeing that you have put off the old man with his doings,
10 and have put on the new man, who is being renewed in knowledge after the image of his Creator,
11 where there can't be Greek and Jew, circumcision and uncircumcision, barbarian, Scythian, bondservant, or free person; but Christ is all, and in all.
12 Put on therefore, as God's chosen ones, holy and beloved, a heart of compassion, kindness, lowliness, humility, and perseverance;
13 bearing with one another, and forgiving each other, if any man has a complaint against any; even as Christ forgave you, so you also do.
14 Above all these things, walk in love, which is the bond of perfection.
15 And let the peace of God rule in your hearts, to which also you were called in one body, and be thankful.
16 Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly; in all wisdom teaching and admonishing one another with psalms, hymns, and spiritual songs, singing with grace in your heart to the Lord.
17 Whatever you do, in word or in deed, do all in the name of the Lord Jesus, giving thanks to God the Father through him.
18 Wives, be in subjection to your husbands, as is fitting in the Lord.
19 Husbands, love your wives, and don't be bitter against them.
20 Children, obey your parents in all things, for this pleases the Lord.
21 Fathers, don't provoke your children, so that they won't be discouraged.
22 Servants, obey in all things those who are your masters according to the flesh, not just when they are looking, as men pleasers, but in singleness of heart, fearing God.
23 And whatever you do, work heartily, as for the Lord and not for men,
24 knowing that from the Lord you will receive the reward of the inheritance; for you serve the Lord Christ.
25 But he who does wrong will receive again for the wrong that he has done, and there is no partiality.

4

1 Masters, give to your servants that which is just and equal, knowing that you also have a Master in heaven.
2 Continue steadfastly in prayer, watching in it with thanksgiving,
3 praying together for us also, that God may open to us a door for the word, to speak the mystery of Christ, for which I am also in bonds,
4 that I may reveal it as I ought to speak.
5 Walk in wisdom toward those who are outside, redeeming the time.
6 Let your speech always be with grace, seasoned with salt, that you may know how you ought to answer each one.
7 All my affairs will be made known to you by Tychicus, the beloved brother, faithful servant, and fellow bondservant in the Lord.
8 I am sending him to you for this very purpose, that he may know your circumstances and comfort your hearts,
9 together with Onesimus, the faithful and beloved brother, who is one of you. They will make known to you everything that is going on here.
10 Aristarchus, my fellow prisoner, greets you, and Mark the cousin of

Barnabas (concerning whom you
received instructions, “if he comes to you,
receive him”),
11 and Jesus who is called Justus. These
are my only fellow workers for God’s
Kingdom who are of the circumcision,
men who have been a comfort to me.
12 Epaphras, who is one of you, a servant
of Christ, salutes you, always striving for
you in his prayers, that you may stand
perfect and complete in all the will of God.
13 For I testify about him that he has
great zeal for you, and for those in
Laodicea, and for those in Hierapolis.
14 Luke the beloved physician and
Demas greet you.
15 Greet the brothers who are in
Laodicea, with Nymphas and the
assembly that is in his house.
16 When this letter has been read among
you, cause it to be read also in the
assembly of the Laodiceans, and that you
also read the letter from Laodicea.
17 Tell Archippus, “Take heed to the
ministry which you have received in the
Lord, that you fulfill it.”
18 I, Paul, write this greeting with my
own hand. Remember my chains. Grace
be with you. Amen.

Paul's First Letter to the Thessalonians

1 Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy, to the
assembly of the Thessalonians in God the
Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:† Grace
to you and peace from God our Father and
the Lord Jesus Christ.
2 We always give thanks to God for all of
you, mentioning you in our prayers,
3 remembering without ceasing your
work of faith and labor of love and
perseverance of hope in our Lord Jesus
Christ, before our God and Father.
4 We know, brothers‡ loved by God, that
you are chosen,
5 and that our Good News came to you
not in word only, but also in power, and in
the Holy Spirit and with much assurance.
You know what kind of men we showed
ourselves to be among you for your sake.
6 You became imitators of us and of the
Lord, having received the word in much
affliction, with joy of the Holy Spirit,
7 so that you became an example to all
who believe in Macedonia and in Achaia.
8 For from you the word of the Lord has
been declared, not only in Macedonia and
Achaia, but also in every place your faith
toward God has gone out, so that we need
not say anything.
9 For they themselves report concerning
us what kind of a reception we had from
you, and how you turned to God from
idols to serve a living and true God,
10 and to wait for his Son from heaven,
whom he raised from the dead: Jesus,
who delivers us from the wrath to come.

2

1 For you yourselves know, brothers,
our visit to you wasn't in vain,
2 but having suffered before and been
shamefully treated, as you know, at
Philippi, we grew bold in our God to tell
you the Good News of God in much
conflict.
3 For our exhortation is not of error, nor
of uncleanness, nor in deception.
4 But even as we have been approved by
God to be entrusted with the Good News,
so we speak—not as pleasing men, but
God, who tests our hearts.
5 For neither were we at any time found
using words of flattery, as you know, nor
a cloak of covetousness (God is witness),
6 nor seeking glory from men (neither
from you nor from others), when we
might have claimed authority as apostles
of Christ.
7 But we were gentle among you, like a
nursing mother cherishes her own
children.
8 Even so, affectionately longing for you,
we were well pleased to impart to you not
the Good News of God only, but also our
own souls, because you had become very
dear to us.
9 For you remember, brothers, our labor
and travail; for working night and day,
that we might not burden any of you, we
preached to you the Good News of God.
10 You are witnesses with God how holy,
righteously, and blamelessly we behaved
ourselves toward you who believe.
11 As you know, we exhorted,
comforted, and implored every one of
you, as a father does his own children,
12 to the end that you should walk
worthily of God, who calls you into his
own Kingdom and glory.
13 For this cause we also thank God
without ceasing that when you received
from us the word of the message of God,
you accepted it not as the word of men,
but as it is in truth, God's word, which also
works in you who believe.
14 For you, brothers, became imitators
of the assemblies of God which are in
Judea in Christ Jesus; for you also suffered
the same things from your own
countrymen, even as they did from the
Jews
15 who killed both the Lord Jesus and
their own prophets, and drove us out, and

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:4** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

don't please God, and are contrary to all men,
16 forbidding us to speak to the Gentiles that they may be saved, to fill up their sins always. But wrath has come on them to the uttermost.
17 But we, brothers, being bereaved of you for a short season in presence, not in heart, tried even harder to see your face with great desire,
18 because we wanted to come to you—indeed, I, Paul, once and again—but Satan hindered us.
19 For what is our hope, or joy, or crown of rejoicing? Isn't it even you, before our Lord Jesus† at his coming?
20 For you are our glory and our joy.

3

1 Therefore when we couldn't stand it any longer, we thought it good to be left behind at Athens alone,
2 and sent Timothy, our brother and God's servant in the Good News of Christ, to establish you and to comfort you concerning your faith,
3 that no one would be moved by these afflictions. For you know that we are appointed to this task.
4 For most certainly, when we were with you, we told you beforehand that we are to suffer affliction, even as it happened, and you know.
5 For this cause I also, when I couldn't stand it any longer, sent that I might know your faith, for fear that by any means the tempter had tempted you, and our labor would have been in vain.
6 But Timothy has just now come to us from you, and brought us glad news of your faith and love, and that you have good memories of us always, longing to see us, even as we also long to see you.
7 For this cause, brothers, we were comforted over you in all our distress and affliction through your faith.
8 For now we live, if you stand fast in the Lord.
9 For what thanksgiving can we give again to God for you, for all the joy with which we rejoice for your sakes before our God,
10 night and day praying exceedingly that we may see your face and may perfect that which is lacking in your faith?
11 Now may our God and Father himself, and our Lord Jesus Christ, direct our way to you.
12 May the Lord make you to increase and abound in love toward one another and toward all men, even as we also do toward you,
13 to the end he may establish your hearts blameless in holiness before our God and Father at the coming of our Lord Jesus with all his saints.

4

1 Finally then, brothers, we beg and exhort you in the Lord Jesus, that as you received from us how you ought to walk and to please God, that you abound more and more.
2 For you know what instructions we gave you through the Lord Jesus.
3 For this is the will of God: your sanctification, that you abstain from sexual immorality,
4 that each one of you know how to control his own body† in sanctification and honor,
5 not in the passion of lust, even as the Gentiles who don't know God,
6 that no one should take advantage of and wrong a brother or sister in this matter; because the Lord is an avenger in all these things, as also we forewarned you and testified.
7 For God called us not for uncleanness, but in sanctification.
8 Therefore he who rejects this doesn't reject man, but God, who has also given his Holy Spirit to you.
9 But concerning brotherly love, you have no need that one write to you. For you yourselves are taught by God to love one another,
10 for indeed you do it toward all the brothers who are in all Macedonia. But

† **2:19** TR adds "Christ" † **4:4** literally, possess his own vessel

we exhort you, brothers, that you abound more and more;
11 and that you make it your ambition to lead a quiet life, and to do your own business, and to work with your own hands, even as we instructed you,
12 that you may walk properly toward those who are outside, and may have need of nothing.
13 But we don't want you to be ignorant, brothers, concerning those who have fallen asleep, so that you don't grieve like the rest, who have no hope.
14 For if we believe that Jesus died and rose again, even so God will bring with him those who have fallen asleep in Jesus.
15 For this we tell you by the word of the Lord, that we who are alive, who are left until the coming of the Lord, will in no way precede those who have fallen asleep.
16 For the Lord himself will descend from heaven with a shout, with the voice of the archangel and with God's trumpet. The dead in Christ will rise first,
17 then we who are alive, who are left, will be caught up together with them in the clouds to meet the Lord in the air. So we will be with the Lord forever.
18 Therefore comfort one another with these words.

5

1 But concerning the times and the seasons, brothers, you have no need that anything be written to you.
2 For you yourselves know well that the day of the Lord comes like a thief in the night.
3 For when they are saying, "Peace and safety," then sudden destruction will come on them, like birth pains on a pregnant woman. Then they will in no way escape.
4 But you, brothers, aren't in darkness, that the day should overtake you like a thief.
5 You are all children of light and children of the day. We don't belong to the night, nor to darkness,
6 so then let's not sleep, as the rest do, but let's watch and be sober.
7 For those who sleep, sleep in the night; and those who are drunk are drunk in the night.
8 But since we belong to the day, let's be sober, putting on the breastplate of faith and love, and for a helmet, the hope of salvation.
9 For God didn't appoint us to wrath, but to the obtaining of salvation through our Lord Jesus Christ,
10 who died for us, that, whether we wake or sleep, we should live together with him.
11 Therefore exhort one another, and build each other up, even as you also do.
12 But we beg you, brothers, to know those who labor among you, and are over you in the Lord and admonish you,
13 and to respect and honor them in love for their work's sake.
Be at peace among yourselves.
14 We exhort you, brothers: Admonish the disorderly; encourage the faint-hearted; support the weak; be patient toward all.
15 See that no one returns evil for evil to anyone, but always follow after that which is good for one another and for all.
16 Always rejoice.
17 Pray without ceasing.
18 In everything give thanks, for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus toward you.
19 Don't quench the Spirit.
20 Don't despise prophecies.
21 Test all things, and hold firmly that which is good.
22 Abstain from every form of evil.
23 May the God of peace himself sanctify you completely. May your whole spirit, soul, and body be preserved blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.
24 He who calls you is faithful, who will also do it.
25 Brothers, pray for us.
26 Greet all the brothers with a holy kiss.
27 I solemnly command you by the Lord that this letter be read to all the holy brothers.
28 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be with you. Amen.

Paul's Second Letter to the Thessalonians

1 Paul, Silvanus, and Timothy, to the
assembly of the Thessalonians in God our
Father and the Lord Jesus Christ:
2 Grace to you and peace from God our
Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.
3 We are bound to always give thanks to
God for you, brothers,† even as it is
appropriate, because your faith grows
exceedingly, and the love of each and
every one of you toward one another
abounds,
4 so that we ourselves boast about you
in the assemblies of God for your
perseverance and faith in all your
persecutions and in the afflictions which
you endure.
5 This is an obvious sign of the righteous
judgment of God, to the end that you may
be counted worthy of God's Kingdom, for
which you also suffer.
6 For it is a righteous thing with God to
repay affliction to those who afflict you,
7 and to give relief to you who are
afflicted with us when the Lord Jesus is
revealed from heaven with his mighty
angels in flaming fire,
8 punishing those who don't know God,
and to those who don't obey the Good
News of our Lord Jesus,
9 who will pay the penalty: eternal
destruction from the face of the Lord and
from the glory of his might,
10 when he comes in that day to be
glorified in his saints and to be admired
among all those who have believed,
because our testimony to you was
believed.
11 To this end we also pray always for
you that our God may count you worthy of
your calling, and fulfill every desire of
goodness and work of faith with power,
12 that the name of our Lord Jesus‡ may
be glorified in you, and you in him,
according to the grace of our God and the
Lord Jesus Christ.

2

1 Now, brothers, concerning the coming
of our Lord Jesus Christ and our gathering
together to him, we ask you
2 not to be quickly shaken in your mind
or troubled, either by spirit or by word or
by letter as if from us, saying that the day
of Christ has already come.
3 Let no one deceive you in any way. For
it will not be unless the rebellion† comes
first, and the man of sin is revealed, the
son of destruction.
4 He opposes and exalts himself against
all that is called God or that is worshiped,
so that he sits as God in the temple of God,
setting himself up as God.
5 Don't you remember that when I was
still with you, I told you these things?
6 Now you know what is restraining
him, to the end that he may be revealed in
his own season.
7 For the mystery of lawlessness already
works. Only there is one who restrains
now, until he is taken out of the way.
8 Then the lawless one will be revealed,
whom the Lord will kill with the breath of
his mouth and destroy by the
manifestation of his coming;
9 even he whose coming is according to
the working of Satan with all power and
signs and lying wonders,
10 and with all deception of wickedness
for those who are being lost, because they
didn't receive the love of the truth, that
they might be saved.
11 Because of this, God sends them a
powerful delusion, that they should
believe a lie,
12 that they all might be judged who
didn't believe the truth, but had pleasure
in unrighteousness.
13 But we are bound to always give
thanks to God for you, brothers loved by
the Lord, because God chose you from the
beginning for salvation through

† **1:3** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." ‡ **1:12** TR adds "Christ" † **2:3** or, *falling away*, or, *defection*

sanctification of the Spirit and belief in
the truth,
14 to which he called you through our
Good News, for the obtaining of the glory
of our Lord Jesus Christ.
15 So then, brothers, stand firm and hold
the traditions which you were taught by
us, whether by word or by letter.

16 Now our Lord Jesus Christ himself,
and God our Father, who loved us and
gave us eternal comfort and good hope
through grace,
17 comfort your hearts and establish
you in every good work and word.

3

1 Finally, brothers, pray for us, that the
word of the Lord may spread rapidly and
be glorified, even as also with you,
2 and that we may be delivered from
unreasonable and evil men; for not all
have faith.
3 But the Lord is faithful, who will
establish you and guard you from the evil
one.
4 We have confidence in the Lord
concerning you, that you both do and will
do the things we command.
5 May the Lord direct your hearts into
God's love and into the perseverance of
Christ.

6 Now we command you, brothers, in
the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that
you withdraw yourselves from every
brother who walks in rebellion and not
after the tradition which they received
from us.
7 For you know how you ought to
imitate us. For we didn't behave ourselves
rebelliously among you,
8 neither did we eat bread from
anyone's hand without paying for it, but
in labor and travail worked night and day,
that we might not burden any of you.
9 This was not because we don't have the
right, but to make ourselves an example
to you, that you should imitate us.
10 For even when we were with you, we
commanded you this: "If anyone is not
willing to work, don't let him eat."

11 For we hear of some who walk among
you in rebellion, who don't work at all,
but are busybodies.
12 Now those who are that way, we
command and exhort in the Lord Jesus
Christ, that they work with quietness and
eat their own bread.
13 But you, brothers, don't be weary in
doing what is right.
14 If any man doesn't obey our word in
this letter, note that man and have no
company with him, to the end that he may
be ashamed.
15 Don't count him as an enemy, but
admonish him as a brother.
16 Now may the Lord of peace himself
give you peace at all times in all ways. The
Lord be with you all.
17 I, Paul, write this greeting with my
own hand, which is the sign in every
letter. This is how I write.
18 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be
with you all. Amen.

Paul's First Letter to Timothy

1 Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ
according to the commandment of God
our Savior and the Lord Jesus Christ† our
hope,
2 to Timothy, my true child in faith:
Grace, mercy, and peace from God our
Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.
3 As I urged you when I was going into
Macedonia, stay at Ephesus that you
might command certain men not to teach
a different doctrine,
4 and not to pay attention to myths and
endless genealogies, which cause disputes
rather than God's stewardship, which is in
faith.
5 But the goal of this command is love
from a pure heart, a good conscience, and
sincere faith,
6 from which things some, having
missed the mark, have turned away to
vain talking,
7 desiring to be teachers of the law,
though they understand neither what
they say nor about what they strongly
affirm.
8 But we know that the law is good if a
person uses it lawfully,
9 as knowing this, that law is not made
for a righteous person, but for the lawless
and insubordinate, for the ungodly and
sinners, for the unholy and profane, for
murderers of fathers and murderers of
mothers, for manslayers,
10 for the sexually immoral, for
homosexuals, for slave-traders, for liars,
for perjurers, and for any other thing
contrary to the sound doctrine,
11 according to the Good News of the
glory of the blessed God, which was
committed to my trust.
12 I thank him who enabled me, Christ
Jesus our Lord, because he counted me
faithful, appointing me to service,
13 although I used to be a blasphemer, a
persecutor, and insolent. However, I
obtained mercy because I did it ignorantly
in unbelief.
14 The grace of our Lord abounded
exceedingly with faith and love which is
in Christ Jesus.
15 The saying is faithful and worthy of
all acceptance, that Christ Jesus came into
the world to save sinners, of whom I am
chief.
16 However, for this cause I obtained
mercy, that in me first, Jesus Christ might
display all his patience for an example of
those who were going to believe in him
for eternal life.
17 Now to the King eternal, immortal,
invisible, to God who alone is wise, be
honor and glory forever and ever. Amen.
18 I commit this instruction to you, my
child Timothy, according to the
prophecies which were given to you
before, that by them you may wage the
good warfare,
19 holding faith and a good conscience,
which some having thrust away made a
shipwreck concerning the faith,
20 of whom are Hymenaeus and
Alexander, whom I delivered to Satan that
they might be taught not to blaspheme.

2

1 I exhort therefore, first of all, that
petitions, prayers, intercessions, and
givings of thanks be made for all men,
2 for kings and all who are in high
places, that we may lead a tranquil and
quiet life in all godliness and reverence.
3 For this is good and acceptable in the
sight of God our Savior,
4 who desires all people to be saved and
come to full knowledge of the truth.
5 For there is one God and one mediator
between God and men, the man Christ
Jesus,
6 who gave himself as a ransom for all,
the testimony at the proper time,
7 to which I was appointed a preacher
and an apostle—I am telling the truth in
Christ, not lying—a teacher of the Gentiles
in faith and truth.

† **1:1** NU reads *Christ Jesus* and omits *the Lord.*

8 I desire therefore that the men in
every place pray, lifting up holy hands
without anger and doubting.
9 In the same way, that women also
adorn themselves in decent clothing, with
modesty and propriety, not† with braided
hair, gold, pearls, or expensive clothing,
10 but with good works, which is
appropriate for women professing
godliness.
11 Let a woman learn in quietness with
full submission.
12 But I don't permit a woman to teach,
nor to exercise authority over a man, but
to be in quietness.
13 For Adam was formed first, then Eve.
14 Adam wasn't deceived, but the
woman, being deceived, has fallen into
disobedience;
15 but she will be saved through her
childbearing, if they continue in faith,
love, and holiness with sobriety.

3

1 This is a faithful saying: someone who
seeks to be an overseer† desires a good
work.
2 The overseer therefore must be
without reproach, the husband of one
wife, temperate, sensible, modest,
hospitable, good at teaching;
3 not a drinker, not violent, not greedy
for money, but gentle, not quarrelsome,
not covetous;
4 one who rules his own house well,
having children in subjection with all
reverence;
5 (for how could someone who doesn't
know how to rule his own house take care
of God's assembly?)
6 not a new convert, lest being puffed up
he fall into the same condemnation as the
devil.
7 Moreover he must have good
testimony from those who are outside, to
avoid falling into reproach and the snare
of the devil.
8 Servants,‡ in the same way, must be
reverent, not double-tongued, not
addicted to much wine, not greedy for
money,
9 holding the mystery of the faith in a
pure conscience.
10 Let them also first be tested; then let
them serve§ if they are blameless.
11 Their wives in the same way must be
reverent, not slanderers, temperate, and
faithful in all things.
12 Let servants† be husbands of one
wife, ruling their children and their own
houses well.
13 For those who have served well‡ gain
for themselves a good standing and great
boldness in the faith which is in Christ
Jesus.
14 These things I write to you, hoping to
come to you shortly,
15 but if I wait long, that you may know
how men ought to behave themselves in
God's house, which is the assembly of the
living God, the pillar and ground of the
truth.
16 Without controversy, the mystery of
godliness is great:

God§ was revealed in the flesh,
justified in the spirit,
seen by angels,
preached among the nations,
believed on in the world,
and received up in glory.

4

1 But the Spirit says expressly that in
later times some will fall away from the
faith, paying attention to seducing spirits
and doctrines of demons,
2 through the hypocrisy of men who
speak lies, branded in their own
conscience as with a hot iron,
3 forbidding marriage and commanding
to abstain from foods which God created
to be received with thanksgiving by those
who believe and know the truth.

† **2:9** The word for "not" is the negative particle "μη" which denies an expected idea, as opposed to the usual word for "not" (ου) which denies a fact. Thus "μη" in this context is denying an expected idea (that women can be properly dressed without good works). † **3:1** or, superintendent, or bishop ‡ **3:8** or, Deacons. § **3:10** or, serve as deacons † **3:12** or, deacons ‡ **3:13** or, served well as deacons § **3:16** NU replaces "God" with "who"

4 For every creature of God is good, and
nothing is to be rejected if it is received
with thanksgiving.
5 For it is sanctified through the word of
God and prayer.
6 If you instruct the brothers of these
things, you will be a good servant of Christ
Jesus, nourished in the words of the faith
and of the good doctrine which you have
followed.
7 But refuse profane and old wives'
fables. Exercise yourself toward
godliness.
8 For bodily exercise has some value,
but godliness has value in all things,
having the promise of the life which is
now and of that which is to come.
9 This saying is faithful and worthy of all
acceptance.
10 For to this end we both labor and
suffer reproach, because we have set our
trust in the living God, who is the Savior of
all men, especially of those who believe.
11 Command and teach these things.
12 Let no man despise your youth; but
be an example to those who believe, in
word, in your way of life, in love, in spirit,
in faith, and in purity.
13 Until I come, pay attention to reading,
to exhortation, and to teaching.
14 Don't neglect the gift that is in you,
which was given to you by prophecy with
the laying on of the hands of the elders.
15 Be diligent in these things. Give
yourself wholly to them, that your
progress may be revealed to all.
16 Pay attention to yourself and to your
teaching. Continue in these things, for in
doing this you will save both yourself and
those who hear you.

5

1 Don't rebuke an older man, but exhort
him as a father; the younger men as
brothers;
2 the elder women as mothers; the
younger as sisters, in all purity.
3 Honor widows who are widows
indeed.
4 But if any widow has children or
grandchildren, let them learn first to
show piety toward their own family and
to repay their parents, for this is†
acceptable in the sight of God.
5 Now she who is a widow indeed and
desolate, has her hope set on God and
continues in petitions and prayers night
and day.
6 But she who gives herself to pleasure
is dead while she lives.
7 Also command these things, that they
may be without reproach.
8 But if anyone doesn't provide for his
own, and especially his own household,
he has denied the faith and is worse than
an unbeliever.
9 Let no one be enrolled as a widow
under sixty years old, having been the
wife of one man,
10 being approved by good works, if she
has brought up children, if she has been
hospitable to strangers, if she has washed
the saints' feet, if she has relieved the
afflicted, and if she has diligently followed
every good work.
11 But refuse younger widows, for when
they have grown wanton against Christ,
they desire to marry,
12 having condemnation, because they
have rejected their first pledge.
13 Besides, they also learn to be idle,
going about from house to house. Not
only idle, but also gossips and busybodies,
saying things which they ought not.
14 I desire therefore that the younger
widows marry, bear children, rule the
household, and give no occasion to the
adversary for insulting.
15 For already some have turned away
after Satan.
16 If any man or woman who believes
has widows, let them relieve them, and
don't let the assembly be burdened, that it
might relieve those who are widows
indeed.
17 Let the elders who rule well be
counted worthy of double honor,
especially those who labor in the word
and in teaching.

† **5:4** TR adds "good and"

18 For the Scripture says, “You shall not muzzle the ox when it treads out the grain.”* And, “The laborer is worthy of his wages.”*
19 Don’t receive an accusation against an elder except at the word of two or three witnesses.
20 Those who sin, reprove in the sight of all, that the rest also may be in fear.
21 I command you in the sight of God, and the Lord Jesus Christ, and the chosen angels, that you observe these things without prejudice, doing nothing by partiality.
22 Lay hands hastily on no one. Don’t be a participant in other people’s sins. Keep yourself pure.
23 Be no longer a drinker of water only, but use a little wine for your stomach’s sake and your frequent infirmities.
24 Some men’s sins are evident, preceding them to judgment, and some also follow later.
25 In the same way also there are good works that are obvious, and those that are otherwise can’t be hidden.

6

1 Let as many as are bondservants under the yoke count their own masters worthy of all honor, that the name of God and the doctrine not be blasphemed.
2 Those who have believing masters, let them not despise them because they are brothers, but rather let them serve them, because those who partake of the benefit are believing and beloved. Teach and exhort these things.
3 If anyone teaches a different doctrine and doesn’t consent to sound words, the words of our Lord Jesus Christ, and to the doctrine which is according to godliness,
4 he is conceited, knowing nothing, but obsessed with arguments, disputes, and word battles, from which come envy, strife, insulting, evil suspicions,
5 constant friction of people of corrupt minds and destitute of the truth, who suppose that godliness is a means of gain. Withdraw yourself from such.†
6 But godliness with contentment is great gain.
7 For we brought nothing into the world, and we certainly can’t carry anything out.
8 But having food and clothing, we will be content with that.
9 But those who are determined to be rich fall into a temptation, a snare, and many foolish and harmful lusts, such as drown men in ruin and destruction.
10 For the love of money is a root of all kinds of evil. Some have been led astray from the faith in their greed, and have pierced themselves through with many sorrows.
11 But you, man of God, flee these things, and follow after righteousness, godliness, faith, love, perseverance, and gentleness.
12 Fight the good fight of faith. Take hold of the eternal life to which you were called, and you confessed the good confession in the sight of many witnesses.
13 I command you before God who gives life to all things, and before Christ Jesus who before Pontius Pilate testified the good confession,
14 that you keep the commandment without spot, blameless until the appearing of our Lord Jesus Christ,
15 which at the right time he will show, who is the blessed and only Ruler, the King of kings and Lord of lords.
16 He alone has immortality, dwelling in unapproachable light, whom no man has seen nor can see, to whom be honor and eternal power. Amen.
17 Charge those who are rich in this present age that they not be arrogant, nor have their hope set on the uncertainty of riches, but on the living God, who richly provides us with everything to enjoy;
18 that they do good, that they be rich in good works, that they be ready to distribute, willing to share;
19 laying up in store for themselves a good foundation against the time to come, that they may lay hold of eternal life.

* **5:18** Deuteronomy 25:4 * **5:18** Luke 10:7; Leviticus 19:13 † **6:5** NU omits “Withdraw yourself from such.”

20 Timothy, guard that which is
committed to you, turning away from the
empty chatter and oppositions of what is
falsely called knowledge,
21 which some profess, and thus have
wandered from the faith.
Grace be with you. Amen.

Paul's Second Letter to Timothy

1 Paul, an apostle of Jesus Christ† through the will of God, according to the promise of the life which is in Christ Jesus,
2 to Timothy, my beloved child: Grace, mercy, and peace, from God the Father and Christ Jesus our Lord.
3 I thank God, whom I serve as my forefathers did, with a pure conscience. How unceasing is my memory of you in my petitions, night and day
4 longing to see you, remembering your tears, that I may be filled with joy;
5 having been reminded of the sincere faith that is in you, which lived first in your grandmother Lois and your mother Eunice and, I am persuaded, in you also.
6 For this cause, I remind you that you should stir up the gift of God which is in you through the laying on of my hands.
7 For God didn't give us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control.
8 Therefore don't be ashamed of the testimony of our Lord, nor of me his prisoner; but endure hardship for the Good News according to the power of God,
9 who saved us and called us with a holy calling, not according to our works, but according to his own purpose and grace, which was given to us in Christ Jesus before times eternal,
10 but has now been revealed by the appearing of our Savior, Christ Jesus, who abolished death, and brought life and immortality to light through the Good News.
11 For this I was appointed as a preacher, an apostle, and a teacher of the Gentiles.
12 For this cause I also suffer these things.

Yet I am not ashamed, for I know him whom I have believed, and I am persuaded that he is able to guard that which I have committed to him against that day.

13 Hold the pattern of sound words which you have heard from me, in faith and love which is in Christ Jesus.
14 That good thing which was committed to you, guard through the Holy Spirit who dwells in us.
15 This you know, that all who are in Asia turned away from me, of whom are Phygelus and Hermogenes.
16 May the Lord grant mercy to the house of Onesiphorus, for he often refreshed me, and was not ashamed of my chain,
17 but when he was in Rome, he sought me diligently and found me
18 (the Lord grant to him to find the Lord's mercy in that day); and in how many things he served at Ephesus, you know very well.

2

1 You therefore, my child, be strengthened in the grace that is in Christ Jesus.
2 The things which you have heard from me among many witnesses, commit the same things to faithful men who will be able to teach others also.
3 You therefore must endure hardship as a good soldier of Christ Jesus.
4 No soldier on duty entangles himself in the affairs of life, that he may please him who enrolled him as a soldier.
5 Also, if anyone competes in athletics, he isn't crowned unless he has competed by the rules.
6 The farmer who labors must be the first to get a share of the crops.
7 Consider what I say, and may the Lord give you understanding in all things.
8 Remember Jesus Christ, risen from the dead, of the offspring† of David, according to my Good News,
9 in which I suffer hardship to the point of chains as a criminal. But God's word isn't chained.
10 Therefore I endure all things for the chosen ones' sake, that they also may obtain the salvation which is in Christ Jesus with eternal glory.

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". † **2:8** or, seed

11 This saying is trustworthy:
“For if we died with him,
we will also live with him.
12 If we endure,
we will also reign with him.
If we deny him,
he also will deny us.
13 If we are faithless,
he remains faithful;
for he can’t deny himself.”
14 Remind them of these things, charging them in the sight of the Lord that they don’t argue about words to no profit, to the subverting of those who hear.
15 Give diligence to present yourself approved by God, a workman who doesn’t need to be ashamed, properly handling the Word of Truth.
16 But shun empty chatter, for it will go further in ungodliness,
17 and those words will consume like gangrene, of whom is Hymenaeus and Philetus:
18 men who have erred concerning the truth, saying that the resurrection is already past, and overthrowing the faith of some.
19 However, God’s firm foundation stands, having this seal: “The Lord knows those who are his,”* and, “Let every one who names the name of the Lord‡ depart from unrighteousness.”
20 Now in a large house there are not only vessels of gold and of silver, but also of wood and of clay. Some are for honor and some for dishonor.
21 If anyone therefore purges himself from these, he will be a vessel for honor, sanctified, and suitable for the master’s use, prepared for every good work.
22 Flee from youthful lusts; but pursue righteousness, faith, love, and peace with those who call on the Lord out of a pure heart.
23 But refuse foolish and ignorant questionings, knowing that they generate strife.
24 The Lord’s servant must not quarrel, but be gentle toward all, able to teach, patient,
25 in gentleness correcting those who oppose him. Perhaps God may give them repentance leading to a full knowledge of the truth,
26 and they may recover themselves out of the devil’s snare, having been taken captive by him to do his will.

3

1 But know this: that in the last days, grievous times will come.
2 For men will be lovers of self, lovers of money, boastful, arrogant, blasphemers, disobedient to parents, unthankful, unholy,
3 without natural affection, unforgiving, slanderers, without self-control, fierce, not lovers of good,
4 traitors, headstrong, conceited, lovers of pleasure rather than lovers of God,
5 holding a form of godliness but having denied its power. Turn away from these, also.
6 For some of these are people who creep into houses and take captive gullible women loaded down with sins, led away by various lusts,
7 always learning and never able to come to the knowledge of the truth.
8 Even as Jannes and Jambres opposed Moses, so these also oppose the truth, men corrupted in mind, who concerning the faith are rejected.
9 But they will proceed no further. For their folly will be evident to all men, as theirs also came to be.
10 But you followed my teaching, conduct, purpose, faith, patience, love, steadfastness,
11 persecutions, and sufferings—those things that happened to me at Antioch, Iconium, and Lystra. I endured those persecutions. The Lord delivered me out of them all.
12 Yes, and all who desire to live godly in Christ Jesus will suffer persecution.
13 But evil men and impostors will grow worse and worse, deceiving and being deceived.

* **2:19** Numbers 16:5 ‡ **2:19** TR reads “Christ” instead of “the Lord”

14 But you remain in the things which
you have learned and have been assured
of, knowing from whom you have learned
them.
15 From infancy, you have known the
holy Scriptures which are able to make
you wise for salvation through faith
which is in Christ Jesus.
16 Every Scripture is God-breathed and†
profitable for teaching, for reproof, for
correction, and for instruction in
righteousness,
17 that each person who belongs to God
may be complete, thoroughly equipped
for every good work.

4

1 I command you therefore before God
and the Lord Jesus Christ, who will judge
the living and the dead at his appearing
and his Kingdom:
2 preach the word; be urgent in season
and out of season; reprove, rebuke, and
exhort with all patience and teaching.
3 For the time will come when they will
not listen to the sound doctrine, but
having itching ears, will heap up for
themselves teachers after their own lusts,
4 and will turn away their ears from the
truth, and turn away to fables.
5 But you be sober in all things, suffer
hardship, do the work of an evangelist,
and fulfill your ministry.
6 For I am already being offered, and the
time of my departure has come.
7 I have fought the good fight. I have
finished the course. I have kept the faith.
8 From now on, the crown of
righteousness is stored up for me, which
the Lord, the righteous judge, will give to
me on that day; and not to me only, but
also to all those who have loved his
appearing.
9 Be diligent to come to me soon,
10 for Demas left me, having loved this
present world, and went to Thessalonica;
Crescens to Galatia; and Titus to Dalmatia.
11 Only Luke is with me. Take Mark and
bring him with you, for he is useful to me
for service.
12 But I sent Tychicus to Ephesus.
13 Bring the cloak that I left at Troas
with Carpus when you come—and the
books, especially the parchments.
14 Alexander the coppersmith did much
evil to me. The Lord will repay him
according to his deeds.
15 Beware of him, for he greatly opposed
our words.
16 At my first defense, no one came to
help me, but all left me. May it not be held
against them.
17 But the Lord stood by me and
strengthened me, that through me the
message might be fully proclaimed, and
that all the Gentiles might hear. So I was
delivered out of the mouth of the lion.
18 And the Lord will deliver me from
every evil work and will preserve me for
his heavenly Kingdom. To him be the
glory forever and ever. Amen.
19 Greet Prisca and Aquila, and the
house of Onesiphorus.
20 Erastus remained at Corinth, but I left
Trophimus at Miletus sick.
21 Be diligent to come before winter.
Eubulus salutes you, as do Pudens, Linus,
Claudia, and all the brothers.
22 The Lord Jesus Christ be with your
spirit. Grace be with you. Amen.

† **3:16** or, Every writing inspired by God is

Paul's Letter to Titus

1 Paul, a servant of God and an apostle
of Jesus Christ,† according to the faith of
God's chosen ones and the knowledge of
the truth which is according to godliness,
2 in hope of eternal life, which God, who
can't lie, promised before time began;
3 but in his own time revealed his word
in the message with which I was
entrusted according to the commandment
of God our Savior,
4 to Titus, my true child according to a
common faith: Grace, mercy, and peace
from God the Father and the Lord Jesus
Christ our Savior.
5 I left you in Crete for this reason, that
you would set in order the things that
were lacking and appoint elders in every
city, as I directed you—
6 if anyone is blameless, the husband of
one wife, having children who believe,
who are not accused of loose or unruly
behavior.
7 For the overseer must be blameless, as
God's steward, not self-pleasing, not easily
angered, not given to wine, not violent,
not greedy for dishonest gain;
8 but given to hospitality, a lover of
good, sober minded, fair, holy,
self-controlled,
9 holding to the faithful word which is
according to the teaching, that he may be
able to exhort in the sound doctrine, and
to convict those who contradict him.
10 For there are also many unruly men,
vain talkers and deceivers, especially
those of the circumcision,
11 whose mouths must be stopped: men
who overthrow whole houses, teaching
things which they ought not, for dishonest
gain's sake.
12 One of them, a prophet of their own,
said, "Cretans are always liars, evil beasts,
and idle gluttons."
13 This testimony is true. For this cause,
reprove them sharply, that they may be
sound in the faith,
14 not paying attention to Jewish fables
and commandments of men who turn
away from the truth.
15 To the pure, all things are pure, but to
those who are defiled and unbelieving,
nothing is pure; but both their mind and
their conscience are defiled.
16 They profess that they know God, but
by their deeds they deny him, being
abominable, disobedient, and unfit for
any good work.

2

1 But say the things which fit sound
doctrine,
2 that older men should be temperate,
sensible, sober minded, sound in faith, in
love, and in perseverance,
3 and that older women likewise be
reverent in behavior, not slanderers nor
enslaved to much wine, teachers of that
which is good,
4 that they may train the young wives to
love their husbands, to love their children,
5 to be sober minded, chaste, workers at
home, kind, being in subjection to their
own husbands, that God's word may not
be blasphemed.
6 Likewise, exhort the younger men to
be sober minded.
7 In all things show yourself an example
of good works. In your teaching, show
integrity, seriousness, incorruptibility,
8 and soundness of speech that can't be
condemned, that he who opposes you
may be ashamed, having no evil thing to
say about us.
9 Exhort servants to be in subjection to
their own masters and to be well-pleasing
in all things, not contradicting,
10 not stealing, but showing all good
fidelity, that they may adorn the doctrine
of God, our Savior, in all things.
11 For the grace of God has appeared,
bringing salvation to all men,
12 instructing us to the intent that,
denying ungodliness and worldly lusts,
we would live soberly, righteously, and
godly in this present age;

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One".

13 looking for the blessed hope and
appearing of the glory of our great God
and Savior, Jesus Christ,
14 who gave himself for us, that he
might redeem us from all iniquity and
purify for himself a people for his own
possession, zealous for good works.
15 Say these things and exhort and
reprove with all authority. Let no one
despise you.

3

1 Remind them to be in subjection to
rulers and to authorities, to be obedient,
to be ready for every good work,
2 to speak evil of no one, not to be
contentious, to be gentle, showing all
humility toward all men.
3 For we were also once foolish,
disobedient, deceived, serving various
lusts and pleasures, living in malice and
envy, hateful, and hating one another.
4 But when the kindness of God our
Savior and his love toward mankind
appeared,
5 not by works of righteousness which
we did ourselves, but according to his
mercy, he saved us through the washing
of regeneration and renewing by the Holy
Spirit,
6 whom he poured out on us richly
through Jesus Christ our Savior;
7 that being justified by his grace, we
might be made heirs according to the
hope of eternal life.
8 This saying is faithful, and concerning
these things I desire that you insist
confidently, so that those who have
believed God may be careful to maintain
good works. These things are good and
profitable to men;
9 but shun foolish questionings,
genealogies, strife, and disputes about the
law; for they are unprofitable and vain.
10 Avoid a factious man after a first and
second warning,
11 knowing that such a one is perverted
and sinful, being self-condemned.
12 When I send Artemas to you, or
Tychicus, be diligent to come to me to
Nicopolis, for I have determined to winter
there.
13 Send Zenas the lawyer and Apollos on
their journey speedily, that nothing may
be lacking for them.
14 Let our people also learn to maintain
good works to meet necessary needs, that
they may not be unfruitful.
15 All who are with me greet you. Greet
those who love us in faith.
Grace be with you all. Amen.

Paul's Letter to Philemon

1 Paul, a prisoner of Christ† Jesus, and
Timothy our brother, to Philemon, our
beloved fellow worker,
2 to the beloved Apphia, to Archippus
our fellow soldier, and to the assembly in
your house:
3 Grace to you and peace from God our
Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.
4 I thank my God always, making
mention of you in my prayers,
5 hearing of your love and of the faith
which you have toward the Lord Jesus
and toward all the saints,
6 that the fellowship of your faith may
become effective in the knowledge of
every good thing which is in us in Christ
Jesus.
7 For we have much joy and comfort in
your love, because the hearts of the saints
have been refreshed through you,
brother.
8 Therefore though I have all boldness
in Christ to command you that which is
appropriate,
9 yet for love's sake I rather appeal to
you, being such a one as Paul, the aged,
but also a prisoner of Jesus Christ.
10 I appeal to you for my child
Onesimus, whom I have become the
father of in my chains,‡
11 who once was useless to you, but now
is useful to you and to me.
12 I am sending him back. Therefore
receive him, that is, my own heart,
13 whom I desired to keep with me, that
on your behalf he might serve me in my
chains for the Good News.
14 But I was willing to do nothing
without your consent, that your goodness
would not be as of necessity, but of free
will.
15 For perhaps he was therefore
separated from you for a while that you
would have him forever,
16 no longer as a slave, but more than a
slave, a beloved brother—especially to me,
but how much rather to you, both in the
flesh and in the Lord.
17 If then you count me a partner,
receive him as you would receive me.
18 But if he has wronged you at all or
owes you anything, put that to my
account.
19 I, Paul, write this with my own hand: I
will repay it (not to mention to you that
you owe to me even your own self
besides).
20 Yes, brother, let me have joy from you
in the Lord. Refresh my heart in the Lord.
21 Having confidence in your obedience,
I write to you, knowing that you will do
even beyond what I say.
22 Also, prepare a guest room for me, for
I hope that through your prayers I will be
restored to you.
23 Epaphras, my fellow prisoner in
Christ Jesus, greets you,
24 as do Mark, Aristarchus, Demas, and
Luke, my fellow workers.
25 The grace of our Lord Jesus Christ be
with your spirit. Amen.

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:10** Onesimus means "useful".

The Letter to the Hebrews

1 God, having in the past spoken to the
fathers through the prophets at many
times and in various ways,
2 has at the end of these days spoken to
us by his Son, whom he appointed heir of
all things, through whom also he made
the worlds.
3 His Son is the radiance of his glory, the
very image of his substance, and
upholding all things by the word of his
power, who, when he had by himself
purified us of our sins, sat down on the
right hand of the Majesty on high,
4 having become as much better than
the angels as the more excellent name he
has inherited is better than theirs.
5 For to which of the angels did he say at
any time,
"You are my Son.
Today I have become your father?"*
and again,
"I will be to him a Father,
and he will be to me a Son?"*
6 When he again brings in the firstborn
into the world he says, "Let all the angels
of God worship him."*
7 Of the angels he says,
"He makes his angels winds,
and his servants a flame of fire."*
8 But of the Son he says,
"Your throne, O God, is forever and ever.
The scepter of uprightness is the
scepter of your Kingdom.
9 You have loved righteousness and hated
iniquity;
therefore God, your God, has
anointed you with the oil of
gladness above your fellows."*
10 And,
"You, Lord, in the beginning, laid the
foundation of the earth.
The heavens are the works of your
hands.
11 They will perish, but you continue.
They all will grow old like a garment
does.
12 You will roll them up like a mantle,
and they will be changed;
but you are the same.
Your years won't fail."*
13 But which of the angels has he told at
any time,
"Sit at my right hand,
until I make your enemies the
footstool of your feet?"*
14 Aren't they all serving spirits, sent out
to do service for the sake of those who will
inherit salvation?

2

1 Therefore we ought to pay greater
attention to the things that were heard,
lest perhaps we drift away.
2 For if the word spoken through angels
proved steadfast, and every transgression
and disobedience received a just penalty,
3 how will we escape if we neglect so
great a salvation—which at the first
having been spoken through the Lord,
was confirmed to us by those who heard,
4 God also testifying with them, both by
signs and wonders, by various works of
power, and by gifts of the Holy Spirit,
according to his own will?
5 For he didn't subject the world to
come, of which we speak, to angels.
6 But one has somewhere testified,
saying,
"What is man, that you think of him?
Or the son of man, that you care for
him?
7 You made him a little lower than the
angels.
You crowned him with glory and
honor.†
8 You have put all things in subjection
under his feet."*
For in that he subjected all things to
him, he left nothing that is not subject to
him. But now we don't yet see all things
subjected to him.

* **1:5** Psalms 2:7 * **1:5** 2 Samuel 7:14; 1 Chronicles 17:13 * **1:6** Deuteronomy 32:43 LXX * **1:7** Psalms 104:4 * **1:9** Psalms 45:6-7 * **1:12** Psalms 102:25-27 * **1:13** Psalms 110:1 † **2:7** TR adds "and set him over the works of your hands" * **2:8** Psalms 8:4-6

9 But we see him who has been made a
little lower than the angels, Jesus, because
of the suffering of death crowned with
glory and honor, that by the grace of God
he should taste of death for everyone.

10 For it became him, for whom are all
things and through whom are all things,
in bringing many children to glory, to
make the author of their salvation perfect
through sufferings.

11 For both he who sanctifies and those
who are sanctified are all from one, for
which cause he is not ashamed to call
them brothers,‡

12 saying,

"I will declare your name to my brothers.
Among the congregation I will sing
your praise."*

13 Again, "I will put my trust in him."
Again, "Behold, here I am with the
children whom God has given me."*

14 Since then the children have shared
in flesh and blood, he also himself in the
same way partook of the same, that
through death he might bring to nothing
him who had the power of death, that is,
the devil,

15 and might deliver all of them who
through fear of death were all their
lifetime subject to bondage.

16 For most certainly, he doesn't give
help to angels, but he gives help to the
offspring§ of Abraham.

17 Therefore he was obligated in all
things to be made like his brothers, that he
might become a merciful and faithful high
priest in things pertaining to God, to make
atonement for the sins of the people.

18 For in that he himself has suffered
being tempted, he is able to help those
who are tempted.

3

1 Therefore, holy brothers, partakers of
a heavenly calling, consider the Apostle
and High Priest of our confession: Jesus,

2 who was faithful to him who
appointed him, as also Moses was in all
his house.

3 For he has been counted worthy of
more glory than Moses, because he who
built the house has more honor than the
house.

4 For every house is built by someone;
but he who built all things is God.

5 Moses indeed was faithful in all his
house as a servant, for a testimony of
those things which were afterward to be
spoken,

6 but Christ† is faithful as a Son over his
house. We are his house, if we hold fast
our confidence and the glorying of our
hope firm to the end.

7 Therefore, even as the Holy Spirit says,
"Today if you will hear his voice,

8 don't harden your hearts as in the
rebellion,
in the day of the trial in the
wilderness,

9 where your fathers tested me and
tried me,
and saw my deeds for forty years.

10 Therefore I was displeased with that
generation,
and said, 'They always err in their
heart,
but they didn't know my ways.'

11 As I swore in my wrath,
'They will not enter into my rest.' "*

12 Beware, brothers, lest perhaps there
might be in any one of you an evil heart of
unbelief, in falling away from the living
God;

13 but exhort one another day by day, so
long as it is called "today", lest any one of
you be hardened by the deceitfulness of
sin.

14 For we have become partakers of
Christ, if we hold the beginning of our
confidence firm to the end,

15 while it is said,
"Today if you will hear his voice,
don't harden your hearts, as in the
rebellion."*

‡ **2:11** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **2:12** Psalms 22:22 * **2:13** Isaiah 8:18 § **2:16** or, seed † **3:6** "Christ" means "Anointed One". * **3:11** Psalms 95:7-11 * **3:15** Psalms 95:7-8

16 For who, when they heard, rebelled?
Wasn't it all those who came out of Egypt
led by Moses?
17 With whom was he displeased forty
years? Wasn't it with those who sinned,
whose bodies fell in the wilderness?
18 To whom did he swear that they
wouldn't enter into his rest, but to those
who were disobedient?
19 We see that they weren't able to enter
in because of unbelief.

4

1 Let's fear therefore, lest perhaps
anyone of you should seem to have come
short of a promise of entering into his rest.
2 For indeed we have had good news
preached to us, even as they also did, but
the word they heard didn't profit them,
because it wasn't mixed with faith by
those who heard.
3 For we who have believed do enter
into that rest, even as he has said, "As I
swore in my wrath, they will not enter
into my rest;"* although the works were
finished from the foundation of the world.
4 For he has said this somewhere about
the seventh day, "God rested on the
seventh day from all his works;"*
5 and in this place again, "They will not
enter into my rest."*

6 Seeing therefore it remains that some
should enter into it, and they to whom the
good news was preached before failed to
enter in because of disobedience,
7 he again defines a certain day, "today",
saying through David so long a time
afterward (just as has been said),

"Today if you will hear his voice,
don't harden your hearts."*

8 For if Joshua had given them rest, he
would not have spoken afterward of
another day.
9 There remains therefore a Sabbath
rest for the people of God.
10 For he who has entered into his rest
has himself also rested from his works, as
God did from his.
11 Let's therefore give diligence to enter
into that rest, lest anyone fall after the
same example of disobedience.
12 For the word of God is living and
active, and sharper than any two-edged
sword, piercing even to the dividing of
soul and spirit, of both joints and marrow,
and is able to discern the thoughts and
intentions of the heart.
13 There is no creature that is hidden
from his sight, but all things are naked
and laid open before the eyes of him to
whom we must give an account.
14 Having then a great high priest who
has passed through the heavens, Jesus,
the Son of God, let's hold tightly to our
confession.
15 For we don't have a high priest who
can't be touched with the feeling of our
infirmities, but one who has been in all
points tempted like we are, yet without
sin.
16 Let's therefore draw near with
boldness to the throne of grace, that we
may receive mercy and may find grace for
help in time of need.

5

1 For every high priest, being taken
from among men, is appointed for men in
things pertaining to God, that he may
offer both gifts and sacrifices for sins.
2 The high priest can deal gently with
those who are ignorant and going astray,
because he himself is also surrounded
with weakness.
3 Because of this, he must offer
sacrifices for sins for the people, as well as
for himself.
4 Nobody takes this honor on himself,
but he is called by God, just like Aaron
was.
5 So also Christ didn't glorify himself to
be made a high priest, but it was he who
said to him,
"You are my Son.
Today I have become your father."*
6 As he says also in another place,
"You are a priest forever,
after the order of Melchizedek."*

* **4:3** Psalms 95:11 * **4:4** Genesis 2:2 * **4:5** Psalms 95:11 * **4:7** Psalms 95:7-8 * **5:5** Psalms 2:7 * **5:6** Psalms 110:4

7 He, in the days of his flesh, having
offered up prayers and petitions with
strong crying and tears to him who was
able to save him from death, and having
been heard for his godly fear,
8 though he was a Son, yet learned
obedience by the things which he
suffered.
9 Having been made perfect, he became
to all of those who obey him the author of
eternal salvation,
10 named by God a high priest after the
order of Melchizedek.
11 About him we have many words to
say, and hard to interpret, seeing you
have become dull of hearing.
12 For although by this time you should
be teachers, you again need to have
someone teach you the rudiments of the
first principles of the revelations of God.
You have come to need milk, and not solid
food.
13 For everyone who lives on milk is not
experienced in the word of righteousness,
for he is a baby.
14 But solid food is for those who are full
grown, who by reason of use have their
senses exercised to discern good and evil.

6

1 Therefore leaving the teaching of the
first principles of Christ, let's press on to
perfection—not laying again a foundation
of repentance from dead works, of faith
toward God,
2 of the teaching of baptisms, of laying
on of hands, of resurrection of the dead,
and of eternal judgment.
3 This will we do, if God permits.
4 For concerning those who were once
enlightened and tasted of the heavenly
gift, and were made partakers of the Holy
Spirit,
5 and tasted the good word of God and
the powers of the age to come,
6 and then fell away, it is impossible to
renew them again to repentance; seeing
they crucify the Son of God for themselves
again, and put him to open shame.
7 For the land which has drunk the rain
that comes often on it and produces a crop
suitable for them for whose sake it is also
tilled, receives blessing from God;
8 but if it bears thorns and thistles, it is
rejected and near being cursed, whose
end is to be burned.
9 But, beloved, we are persuaded of
better things for you, and things that
accompany salvation, even though we
speak like this.
10 For God is not unrighteous, so as to
forget your work and the labor of love
which you showed toward his name, in
that you served the saints, and still do
serve them.
11 We desire that each one of you may
show the same diligence to the fullness of
hope even to the end,
12 that you won't be sluggish, but
imitators of those who through faith and
perseverance inherited the promises.
13 For when God made a promise to
Abraham, since he could swear by no one
greater, he swore by himself,
14 saying, "Surely blessing I will bless
you, and multiplying I will multiply you."*
15 Thus, having patiently endured, he
obtained the promise.
16 For men indeed swear by a greater
one, and in every dispute of theirs the
oath is final for confirmation.
17 In this way God, being determined to
show more abundantly to the heirs of the
promise the immutability of his counsel,
interposed with an oath,
18 that by two immutable things, in
which it is impossible for God to lie, we
may have a strong encouragement, who
have fled for refuge to take hold of the
hope set before us.
19 This hope we have as an anchor of the
soul, a hope both sure and steadfast and
entering into that which is within the veil,
20 where as a forerunner Jesus entered
for us, having become a high priest
forever after the order of Melchizedek.

7

1 For this Melchizedek, king of Salem,

* **6:14** Genesis 22:17

priest of God Most High, who met
Abraham returning from the slaughter of
the kings and blessed him,
2 to whom also Abraham divided a tenth
part of all (being first, by interpretation,
“king of righteousness”, and then also
“king of Salem”, which means “king of
peace”,
3 without father, without mother,
without genealogy, having neither
beginning of days nor end of life, but
made like the Son of God), remains a
priest continually.

4 Now consider how great this man was,
to whom even Abraham the patriarch
gave a tenth out of the best plunder.
5 They indeed of the sons of Levi who
receive the priest’s office have a
commandment to take tithes from the
people according to the law, that is, of
their brothers, though these have come
out of the body of Abraham,
6 but he whose genealogy is not counted
from them has accepted tithes from
Abraham, and has blessed him who has
the promises.
7 But without any dispute the lesser is
blessed by the greater.
8 Here people who die receive tithes, but
there one receives tithes of whom it is
testified that he lives.
9 We can say that through Abraham
even Levi, who receives tithes, has paid
tithes,
10 for he was yet in the body of his
father when Melchizedek met him.

11 Now if perfection was through the
Levitical priesthood (for under it the
people have received the law), what
further need was there for another priest
to arise after the order of Melchizedek,
and not be called after the order of Aaron?
12 For the priesthood being changed,
there is of necessity a change made also in
the law.
13 For he of whom these things are said
belongs to another tribe, from which no
one has officiated at the altar.
14 For it is evident that our Lord has
sprung out of Judah, about which tribe
Moses spoke nothing concerning
priesthood.
15 This is yet more abundantly evident,
if after the likeness of Melchizedek there
arises another priest,
16 who has been made, not after the law
of a fleshly commandment, but after the
power of an endless life;
17 for it is testified,
“You are a priest forever,
according to the order of
Melchizedek.”*
18 For there is an annulling of a
foregoing commandment because of its
weakness and uselessness
19 (for the law made nothing perfect),
and a bringing in of a better hope,
through which we draw near to God.
20 Inasmuch as he was not made priest
without the taking of an oath
21 (for they indeed have been made
priests without an oath), but he with an
oath by him that says of him,
“The Lord swore and will not change his
mind,
‘You are a priest forever,
according to the order of
Melchizedek.’ ”*
22 By so much, Jesus has become the
guarantee of a better covenant.
23 Many, indeed, have been made
priests, because they are hindered from
continuing by death.
24 But he, because he lives forever, has
his priesthood unchangeable.
25 Therefore he is also able to save to the
uttermost those who draw near to God
through him, seeing that he lives forever
to make intercession for them.
26 For such a high priest was fitting for
us: holy, guiltless, undefiled, separated
from sinners, and made higher than the
heavens;
27 who doesn’t need, like those high
priests, to offer up sacrifices daily, first for
his own sins, and then for the sins of the
people. For he did this once for all, when
he offered up himself.
28 For the law appoints men as high
priests who have weakness, but the word

* **7:17** Psalms 110:4 * **7:21** Psalms 110:4

of the oath, which came after the law,
appoints a Son forever who has been
perfected.

8

1 Now in the things which we are saying,
the main point is this: we have such a high
priest, who sat down on the right hand of
the throne of the Majesty in the heavens,
2 a servant of the sanctuary and of the
true tabernacle which the Lord pitched,
not man.
3 For every high priest is appointed to
offer both gifts and sacrifices. Therefore it
is necessary that this high priest also have
something to offer.
4 For if he were on earth, he would not
be a priest at all, seeing there are priests
who offer the gifts according to the law,
5 who serve a copy and shadow of the
heavenly things, even as Moses was
warned by God when he was about to
make the tabernacle, for he said, "See, you
shall make everything according to the
pattern that was shown to you on the
mountain."*
6 But now he has obtained a more
excellent ministry, by as much as he is
also the mediator of a better covenant,
which on better promises has been given
as law.
7 For if that first covenant had been
faultless, then no place would have been
sought for a second.
8 For finding fault with them, he said,
"Behold,† the days are coming", says the
Lord,
"that I will make a new covenant with
the house of Israel and with the
house of Judah;
9 not according to the covenant that I
made with their fathers
in the day that I took them by the
hand to lead them out of the land of
Egypt;
for they didn't continue in my covenant,
and I disregarded them," says the
Lord.
10 "For this is the covenant that I will make
with the house of Israel
after those days," says the Lord:
"I will put my laws into their mind;
I will also write them on their heart.
I will be their God,
and they will be my people.
11 They will not teach every man his
fellow citizen‡
and every man his brother, saying,
'Know the Lord,'
for all will know me,
from their least to their greatest.
12 For I will be merciful to their
unrighteousness.
I will remember their sins and
lawless deeds no more."*
13 In that he says, "A new covenant", he
has made the first obsolete. But that
which is becoming obsolete and grows
aged is near to vanishing away.

9

1 Now indeed even the first† covenant
had ordinances of divine service and an
earthly sanctuary.
2 For a tabernacle was prepared. In the
first part were the lamp stand, the table,
and the show bread, which is called the
Holy Place.
3 After the second veil was the
tabernacle which is called the Holy of
Holies,
4 having a golden altar of incense and
the ark of the covenant overlaid on all
sides with gold, in which was a golden pot
holding the manna, Aaron's rod that
budded, and the tablets of the covenant;
5 and above it cherubim of glory
overshadowing the mercy seat, of which
things we can't speak now in detail.
6 Now these things having been thus
prepared, the priests go in continually
into the first tabernacle, accomplishing
the services,
7 but into the second the high priest
alone, once in the year, not without blood,
which he offers for himself and for the
errors of the people.
8 The Holy Spirit is indicating this, that
the way into the Holy Place wasn't yet

* **8:5** Exodus 25:40 † **8:8** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. ‡ **8:11** TR reads "neighbor" instead of "fellow citizen" * **8:12** Jeremiah 31:31-34 † **9:1** TR adds "tabernacle"

revealed while the first tabernacle was still standing.
9 This is a symbol of the present age, where gifts and sacrifices are offered that are incapable, concerning the conscience, of making the worshiper perfect,
10 being only (with foods and drinks and various washings) fleshly ordinances, imposed until a time of reformation.

11 But Christ having come as a high priest of the coming good things, through the greater and more perfect tabernacle, not made with hands, that is to say, not of this creation,
12 nor yet through the blood of goats and calves, but through his own blood, entered in once for all into the Holy Place, having obtained eternal redemption.
13 For if the blood of goats and bulls, and the ashes of a heifer sprinkling those who have been defiled, sanctify to the cleanness of the flesh,
14 how much more will the blood of Christ, who through the eternal Spirit offered himself without defect to God, cleanse your conscience from dead works to serve the living God?
15 For this reason he is the mediator of a new covenant, since a death has occurred for the redemption of the transgressions that were under the first covenant, that those who have been called may receive the promise of the eternal inheritance.
16 For where a last will and testament is, there must of necessity be the death of him who made it.
17 For a will is in force where there has been death, for it is never in force while he who made it lives.
18 Therefore even the first covenant has not been dedicated without blood.
19 For when every commandment had been spoken by Moses to all the people according to the law, he took the blood of the calves and the goats, with water and scarlet wool and hyssop, and sprinkled both the book itself and all the people,
20 saying, “This is the blood of the covenant which God has commanded you.”*
21 He sprinkled the tabernacle and all the vessels of the ministry in the same way with the blood.
22 According to the law, nearly everything is cleansed with blood, and apart from shedding of blood there is no remission.
23 It was necessary therefore that the copies of the things in the heavens should be cleansed with these, but the heavenly things themselves with better sacrifices than these.
24 For Christ hasn’t entered into holy places made with hands, which are representations of the true, but into heaven itself, now to appear in the presence of God for us;
25 nor yet that he should offer himself often, as the high priest enters into the holy place year by year with blood not his own,
26 or else he must have suffered often since the foundation of the world. But now once at the end of the ages, he has been revealed to put away sin by the sacrifice of himself.
27 Inasmuch as it is appointed for men to die once, and after this, judgment,
28 so Christ also, having been offered once to bear the sins of many, will appear a second time, not to deal with sin, but to save those who are eagerly waiting for him.

10

1 For the law, having a shadow of the good to come, not the very image of the things, can never with the same sacrifices year by year, which they offer continually, make perfect those who draw near.
2 Or else wouldn’t they have ceased to be offered, because the worshipers, having been once cleansed, would have had no more consciousness of sins?
3 But in those sacrifices there is a yearly reminder of sins.
4 For it is impossible that the blood of bulls and goats should take away sins.
5 Therefore when he comes into the world, he says,
“You didn’t desire sacrifice and offering,

* **9:20** Exodus 24:8

but you prepared a body for me.
6 You had no pleasure in whole burnt
offerings and sacrifices for sin.
7 Then I said, 'Behold, I have come (in
the scroll of the book it is written of
me)
to do your will, O God.' "*
8 Previously saying, "Sacrifices and offerings and whole burnt offerings and sacrifices for sin you didn't desire, neither had pleasure in them" (those which are offered according to the law),
9 then he has said, "Behold, I have come to do your will." He takes away the first, that he may establish the second,
10 by which will we have been sanctified through the offering of the body of Jesus Christ once for all.
11 Every priest indeed stands day by day serving and offering often the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins,
12 but he, when he had offered one sacrifice for sins forever, sat down on the right hand of God,
13 from that time waiting until his enemies are made the footstool of his feet.
14 For by one offering he has perfected forever those who are being sanctified.
15 The Holy Spirit also testifies to us, for after saying,
16 "This is the covenant that I will make
with them
after those days," says the Lord,
"I will put my laws on their heart,
I will also write them on their mind;"*
then he says,
17 "I will remember their sins and their
iniquities no more."*
18 Now where remission of these is, there is no more offering for sin.
19 Having therefore, brothers, boldness to enter into the holy place by the blood of Jesus,
20 by the way which he dedicated for us, a new and living way, through the veil, that is to say, his flesh,
21 and having a great priest over God's house,
22 let's draw near with a true heart in fullness of faith, having our hearts sprinkled from an evil conscience and having our body washed with pure water,
23 let's hold fast the confession of our hope without wavering; for he who promised is faithful.
24 Let's consider how to provoke one another to love and good works,
25 not forsaking our own assembling together, as the custom of some is, but exhorting one another, and so much the more as you see the Day approaching.
26 For if we sin willfully after we have received the knowledge of the truth, there remains no more a sacrifice for sins,
27 but a certain fearful expectation of judgment, and a fierceness of fire which will devour the adversaries.
28 A man who disregards Moses' law dies without compassion on the word of two or three witnesses.
29 How much worse punishment do you think he will be judged worthy of who has trodden under foot the Son of God, and has counted the blood of the covenant with which he was sanctified an unholy thing, and has insulted the Spirit of grace?
30 For we know him who said, "Vengeance belongs to me. I will repay," says the Lord.* Again, "The Lord will judge his people."*
31 It is a fearful thing to fall into the hands of the living God.
32 But remember the former days, in which, after you were enlightened, you endured a great struggle with sufferings:
33 partly, being exposed to both reproaches and oppressions, and partly, becoming partakers with those who were treated so.
34 For you both had compassion on me in my chains and joyfully accepted the plundering of your possessions, knowing that you have for yourselves a better possession and an enduring one in the heavens.
35 Therefore don't throw away your boldness, which has a great reward.

* **10:7** Psalms 40:6-8 * **10:16** Jeremiah 31:33 * **10:17** Jeremiah 31:34 * **10:30** Deuteronomy 32:35 * **10:30** Deuteronomy 32:36; Psalms 135:14

36 For you need endurance so that,
having done the will of God, you may
receive the promise.
37 "In a very little while,
he who comes will come and will not
wait.
38 But the righteous one will live by faith.
If he shrinks back, my soul has no
pleasure in him."*
39 But we are not of those who shrink
back to destruction, but of those who have
faith to the saving of the soul.

11

1 Now faith is assurance of things hoped
for, proof of things not seen.
2 For by this, the elders obtained
approval.
3 By faith we understand that the
universe has been framed by the word of
God, so that what is seen has not been
made out of things which are visible.
4 By faith Abel offered to God a more
excellent sacrifice than Cain, through
which he had testimony given to him that
he was righteous, God testifying with
respect to his gifts; and through it he,
being dead, still speaks.
5 By faith Enoch was taken away, so that
he wouldn't see death, and he was not
found, because God translated him. For
he has had testimony given to him that
before his translation he had been well
pleasing to God.
6 Without faith it is impossible to be well
pleasing to him, for he who comes to God
must believe that he exists, and that he is
a rewarder of those who seek him.
7 By faith Noah, being warned about
things not yet seen, moved with godly
fear,† prepared a ship for the saving of his
house, through which he condemned the
world and became heir of the
righteousness which is according to faith.
8 By faith Abraham, when he was called,
obeyed to go out to the place which he
was to receive for an inheritance. He
went out, not knowing where he went.
9 By faith he lived as an alien in the land
of promise, as in a land not his own,
dwelling in tents with Isaac and Jacob, the
heirs with him of the same promise.
10 For he was looking for the city which
has foundations, whose builder and
maker is God.
11 By faith even Sarah herself received
power to conceive, and she bore a child
when she was past age, since she counted
him faithful who had promised.
12 Therefore as many as the stars of the
sky in multitude, and as innumerable as
the sand which is by the sea shore, were
fathered by one man, and him as good as
dead.
13 These all died in faith, not having
received the promises, but having seen‡
them and embraced them from afar, and
having confessed that they were strangers
and pilgrims on the earth.
14 For those who say such things make it
clear that they are seeking a country of
their own.
15 If indeed they had been thinking of
that country from which they went out,
they would have had enough time to
return.
16 But now they desire a better country,
that is, a heavenly one. Therefore God is
not ashamed of them, to be called their
God, for he has prepared a city for them.
17 By faith, Abraham, being tested,
offered up Isaac. Yes, he who had gladly
received the promises was offering up his
only born§ son,
18 to whom it was said, "Your offspring
will be accounted as from Isaac," *
19 concluding that God is able to raise up
even from the dead. Figuratively
speaking, he also did receive him back
from the dead.
20 By faith Isaac blessed Jacob and Esau,
even concerning things to come.
21 By faith Jacob, when he was dying,
blessed each of the sons of Joseph, and
worshiped, leaning on the top of his staff.

* **10:38** Habakkuk 2:3-4 † **11:7** or, reverence ‡ **11:13** TR adds "and being convinced of" § **11:17** The phrase "only born" is from the Greek word "μονογενη", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only".
* **11:18** Genesis 21:12

22 By faith Joseph, when his end was
near, made mention of the departure of
the children of Israel, and gave
instructions concerning his bones.
23 By faith Moses, when he was born,
was hidden for three months by his
parents, because they saw that he was a
beautiful child; and they were not afraid
of the king's commandment.
24 By faith Moses, when he had grown
up, refused to be called the son of
Pharaoh's daughter,
25 choosing rather to share ill treatment
with God's people than to enjoy the
pleasures of sin for a time,
26 considering the reproach of Christ
greater riches than the treasures of Egypt;
for he looked to the reward.
27 By faith he left Egypt, not fearing the
wrath of the king; for he endured, as
seeing him who is invisible.
28 By faith he kept the Passover and the
sprinkling of the blood, that the destroyer
of the firstborn should not touch them.
29 By faith they passed through the Red
Sea as on dry land. When the Egyptians
tried to do so, they were swallowed up.
30 By faith the walls of Jericho fell down
after they had been encircled for seven
days.
31 By faith Rahab the prostitute didn't
perish with those who were disobedient,
having received the spies in peace.
32 What more shall I say? For the time
would fail me if I told of Gideon, Barak,
Samson, Jephthah, David, Samuel, and the
prophets—
33 who through faith subdued
kingdoms, worked out righteousness,
obtained promises, stopped the mouths of
lions,*
34 quenched the power of fire,* escaped
the edge of the sword,* from weakness
were made strong, grew mighty in war,
and caused foreign armies to flee.
35 Women received their dead by
resurrection.* Others were tortured, not
accepting their deliverance, that they
might obtain a better resurrection.
36 Others were tried by mocking and
scourging, yes, moreover by bonds and
imprisonment.
37 They were stoned.* They were sawn
apart. They were tempted. They were
slain with the sword.* They went around
in sheep skins and in goat skins; being
destitute, afflicted, ill-treated—
38 of whom the world was not
worthy—wandering in deserts,
mountains, caves, and the holes of the
earth.
39 These all, having been commended
for their faith, didn't receive the promise,
40 God having provided some better
thing concerning us, so that apart from us
they should not be made perfect.

12

1 Therefore let's also, seeing we are
surrounded by so great a cloud of
witnesses, lay aside every weight and the
sin which so easily entangles us, and let's
run with perseverance the race that is set
before us,
2 looking to Jesus, the author and
perfecter of faith, who for the joy that was
set before him endured the cross,
despising its shame, and has sat down at
the right hand of the throne of God.
3 For consider him who has endured
such contradiction of sinners against
himself, that you don't grow weary,
fainting in your souls.
4 You have not yet resisted to blood,
striving against sin.
5 You have forgotten the exhortation
which reasons with you as with children,
"My son, don't take lightly the chastening
of the Lord,
nor faint when you are reproved by
him;
6 for whom the Lord loves, he
disciplines,
and chastises every son whom he
receives."*

* **11:33** Daniel 6:22-23 * **11:34** Daniel 3:1-30 * **11:34** 1 Kings 19:1-3; 2 Kings 6:31—7:20 * **11:35** 1 Kings 17:17-23; 2 Kings 4:32-37 * **11:37** 2 Chronicles 24:20-21 * **11:37** Jeremiah 26:20-23; 1 Kings 19:10 * **12:6** Proverbs 3:11-12

7 It is for discipline that you endure.
God deals with you as with children, for
what son is there whom his father doesn't
discipline?
8 But if you are without discipline, of
which all have been made partakers, then
you are illegitimate, and not children.
9 Furthermore, we had the fathers of
our flesh to chasten us, and we paid them
respect. Shall we not much rather be in
subjection to the Father of spirits and live?
10 For they indeed for a few days
disciplined us as seemed good to them,
but he for our profit, that we may be
partakers of his holiness.
11 All chastening seems for the present
to be not joyous but grievous; yet
afterward it yields the peaceful fruit of
righteousness to those who have been
trained by it.
12 Therefore lift up the hands that hang
down and the feeble knees,*
13 and make straight paths for your
feet,* so what is lame may not be
dislocated, but rather be healed.
14 Follow after peace with all men, and
the sanctification without which no man
will see the Lord,
15 looking carefully lest there be any
man who falls short of the grace of God,
lest any root of bitterness springing up
trouble you and many be defiled by it,
16 lest there be any sexually immoral
person or profane person, like Esau, who
sold his birthright for one meal.
17 For you know that even when he
afterward desired to inherit the blessing,
he was rejected, for he found no place for
a change of mind though he sought it
diligently with tears.
18 For you have not come to a mountain
that might be touched and that burned
with fire, and to blackness, darkness,
storm,
19 the sound of a trumpet, and the voice
of words; which those who heard it
begged that not one more word should be
spoken to them,
20 for they could not stand that which
was commanded, "If even an animal
touches the mountain, it shall be
stoned".†*
21 So fearful was the appearance that
Moses said, "I am terrified and
trembling."*
22 But you have come to Mount Zion and
to the city of the living God, the heavenly
Jerusalem, and to innumerable
multitudes of angels,
23 to the festal gathering and assembly
of the firstborn who are enrolled in
heaven, to God the Judge of all, to the
spirits of just men made perfect,
24 to Jesus, the mediator of a new
covenant,* and to the blood of sprinkling
that speaks better than that of Abel.
25 See that you don't refuse him who
speaks. For if they didn't escape when
they refused him who warned on the
earth, how much more will we not escape
who turn away from him who warns from
heaven,
26 whose voice shook the earth then, but
now he has promised, saying, "Yet once
more I will shake not only the earth, but
also the heavens."*
27 This phrase, "Yet once more" signifies
the removing of those things that are
shaken, as of things that have been made,
that those things which are not shaken
may remain.
28 Therefore, receiving a Kingdom that
can't be shaken, let's have grace, through
which we serve God acceptably, with
reverence and awe,
29 for our God is a consuming fire.*

13

1 Let brotherly love continue.
2 Don't forget to show hospitality to
strangers, for in doing so, some have
entertained angels without knowing it.
3 Remember those who are in bonds, as
bound with them, and those who are
ill-treated, since you are also in the body.

* **12:12** Isaiah 35:3 * **12:13** Proverbs 4:26 † **12:20** TR adds "or shot with an arrow" * **12:20** Exodus 19:12-13
* **12:21** Deuteronomy 9:19 * **12:24** Jeremiah 31:31 * **12:26** Haggai 2:6 * **12:29** Deuteronomy 4:24

4 Let marriage be held in honor among
all, and let the bed be undefiled; but God
will judge the sexually immoral and
adulterers.
5 Be free from the love of money,
content with such things as you have, for
he has said, “I will in no way leave you,
neither will I in any way forsake you.”*
6 So that with good courage we say,
“The Lord is my helper. I will not fear.
What can man do to me?”*
7 Remember your leaders, men who
spoke to you the word of God, and
considering the results of their conduct,
imitate their faith.
8 Jesus Christ is the same yesterday,
today, and forever.
9 Don’t be carried away by various and
strange teachings, for it is good that the
heart be established by grace, not by
foods, through which those who were so
occupied were not benefited.
10 We have an altar from which those
who serve the holy tabernacle have no
right to eat.
11 For the bodies of those animals,
whose blood is brought into the holy place
by the high priest as an offering for sin,
are burned outside of the camp.*
12 Therefore Jesus also, that he might
sanctify the people through his own
blood, suffered outside of the gate.
13 Let’s therefore go out to him outside
of the camp, bearing his reproach.
14 For we don’t have here an enduring
city, but we seek that which is to come.
15 Through him, then, let’s offer up a
sacrifice of praise to God* continually,
that is, the fruit of lips which proclaim
allegiance to his name.
16 But don’t forget to be doing good and
sharing, for with such sacrifices God is
well pleased.
17 Obey your leaders and submit to
them, for they watch on behalf of your
souls, as those who will give account, that
they may do this with joy and not with
groaning, for that would be unprofitable
for you.
18 Pray for us, for we are persuaded that
we have a good conscience, desiring to
live honorably in all things.
19 I strongly urge you to do this, that I
may be restored to you sooner.
20 Now may the God of peace, who
brought again from the dead the great
shepherd of the sheep with the blood of
an eternal covenant, our Lord Jesus,
21 make you complete in every good
work to do his will, working in you that
which is well pleasing in his sight,
through Jesus Christ, to whom be the
glory forever and ever. Amen.
22 But I exhort you, brothers, endure the
word of exhortation, for I have written to
you in few words.
23 Know that our brother Timothy has
been freed, with whom, if he comes
shortly, I will see you.
24 Greet all of your leaders and all the
saints. The Italians greet you.
25 Grace be with you all. Amen.

* **13:5** Deuteronomy 31:6 * **13:6** Psalms 118:6-7 * **13:11** Leviticus 16:27 * **13:15** Psalms 50:23

The Letter from James

1 James, a servant of God and of the
Lord Jesus Christ,† to the twelve tribes
which are in the Dispersion: Greetings.
2 Count it all joy, my brothers,‡ when
you fall into various temptations,
3 knowing that the testing of your faith
produces endurance.
4 Let endurance have its perfect work,
that you may be perfect and complete,
lacking in nothing.
5 But if any of you lacks wisdom, let him
ask of God, who gives to all liberally and
without reproach, and it will be given to
him.
6 But let him ask in faith, without any
doubting, for he who doubts is like a wave
of the sea, driven by the wind and tossed.
7 For that man shouldn't think that he
will receive anything from the Lord.
8 He is a double-minded man, unstable
in all his ways.
9 Let the brother in humble
circumstances glory in his high position;
10 and the rich, in that he is made
humble, because like the flower in the
grass, he will pass away.
11 For the sun arises with the scorching
wind and withers the grass; and the
flower in it falls, and the beauty of its
appearance perishes. So the rich man will
also fade away in his pursuits.
12 Blessed is a person who endures
temptation, for when he has been
approved, he will receive the crown of life
which the Lord promised to those who
love him.
13 Let no man say when he is tempted, "I
am tempted by God," for God can't be
tempted by evil, and he himself tempts no
one.
14 But each one is tempted when he is
drawn away by his own lust and enticed.
15 Then the lust, when it has conceived,
bears sin. The sin, when it is full grown,
produces death.
16 Don't be deceived, my beloved
brothers.
17 Every good gift and every perfect gift
is from above, coming down from the
Father of lights, with whom can be no
variation nor turning shadow.
18 Of his own will he gave birth to us by
the word of truth, that we should be a
kind of first fruits of his creatures.
19 So, then, my beloved brothers, let
every man be swift to hear, slow to speak,
and slow to anger;
20 for the anger of man doesn't produce
the righteousness of God.
21 Therefore, putting away all filthiness
and overflowing of wickedness, receive
with humility the implanted word, which
is able to save your souls.§
22 But be doers of the word, and not only
hearers, deluding your own selves.
23 For if anyone is a hearer of the word
and not a doer, he is like a man looking at
his natural face in a mirror;
24 for he sees himself, and goes away,
and immediately forgets what kind of
man he was.
25 But he who looks into the perfect law
of freedom and continues, not being a
hearer who forgets but a doer of the work,
this man will be blessed in what he does.
26 If anyone among you thinks himself
to be religious while he doesn't bridle his
tongue, but deceives his heart, this man's
religion is worthless.
27 Pure religion and undefiled before
our God and Father is this: to visit the
fatherless and widows in their affliction,
and to keep oneself unstained by the
world.

2

1 My brothers, don't hold the faith of our
glorious Lord Jesus Christ with partiality.
2 For if a man with a gold ring, in fine
clothing, comes into your synagogue,† and
a poor man in filthy clothing also comes
in,
3 and you pay special attention to him
who wears the fine clothing and say, "Sit

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:2** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." § **1:21** or, preserve your life. † **2:2** or, meeting

here in a good place;" and you tell the poor man, "Stand there," or "Sit by my footstool"
4 haven't you shown partiality among yourselves, and become judges with evil thoughts?
5 Listen, my beloved brothers. Didn't God choose those who are poor in this world to be rich in faith and heirs of the Kingdom which he promised to those who love him?
6 But you have dishonored the poor man. Don't the rich oppress you and personally drag you before the courts?
7 Don't they blaspheme the honorable name by which you are called?
8 However, if you fulfill the royal law according to the Scripture, "You shall love your neighbor as yourself,"* you do well.
9 But if you show partiality, you commit sin, being convicted by the law as transgressors.
10 For whoever keeps the whole law, and yet stumbles in one point, he has become guilty of all.
11 For he who said, "Do not commit adultery,"* also said, "Do not commit murder."* Now if you do not commit adultery but do murder, you have become a transgressor of the law.
12 So speak and so do as men who are to be judged by the law of freedom.
13 For judgment is without mercy to him who has shown no mercy. Mercy triumphs over judgment.
14 What good is it, my brothers, if a man says he has faith, but has no works? Can faith save him?
15 And if a brother or sister is naked and in lack of daily food,
16 and one of you tells them, "Go in peace. Be warmed and filled;" yet you didn't give them the things the body needs, what good is it?
17 Even so faith, if it has no works, is dead in itself.
18 Yes, a man will say, "You have faith, and I have works." Show me your faith without works, and I will show you my faith by my works.
19 You believe that God is one. You do well. The demons also believe—and shudder.
20 But do you want to know, vain man, that faith apart from works is dead?
21 Wasn't Abraham our father justified by works, in that he offered up Isaac his son on the altar?
22 You see that faith worked with his works, and by works faith was perfected.
23 So the Scripture was fulfilled which says, "Abraham believed God, and it was accounted to him as righteousness,"* and he was called the friend of God.
24 You see then that by works a man is justified, and not only by faith.
25 In the same way, wasn't Rahab the prostitute also justified by works when she received the messengers and sent them out another way?
26 For as the body apart from the spirit is dead, even so faith apart from works is dead.

3

1 Let not many of you be teachers, my brothers, knowing that we will receive heavier judgment.
2 For we all stumble in many things. Anyone who doesn't stumble in word is a perfect person, able to bridle the whole body also.
3 Indeed, we put bits into the horses' mouths so that they may obey us, and we guide their whole body.
4 Behold,† the ships also, though they are so big and are driven by fierce winds, are yet guided by a very small rudder, wherever the pilot desires.
5 So the tongue is also a little member, and boasts great things. See how a small fire can spread to a large forest!
6 And the tongue is a fire. The world of iniquity among our members is the tongue, which defiles the whole body, and sets on fire the course of nature, and is set on fire by Gehenna.‡

* **2:8** Leviticus 19:18 * **2:11** Exodus 20:14; Deuteronomy 5:18 * **2:11** Exodus 20:13; Deuteronomy 5:17 * **2:23** Genesis 15:6 † **3:4** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. ‡ **3:6** or, Hell

7 For every kind of animal, bird,
creeping thing, and sea creature is tamed,
and has been tamed by mankind;
8 but nobody can tame the tongue. It is a
restless evil, full of deadly poison.
9 With it we bless our God and Father,
and with it we curse men who are made
in the image of God.
10 Out of the same mouth comes
blessing and cursing. My brothers, these
things ought not to be so.
11 Does a spring send out from the same
opening fresh and bitter water?
12 Can a fig tree, my brothers, yield
olives, or a vine figs? Thus no spring
yields both salt water and fresh water.
13 Who is wise and understanding
among you? Let him show by his good
conduct that his deeds are done in
gentleness of wisdom.
14 But if you have bitter jealousy and
selfish ambition in your heart, don't boast
and don't lie against the truth.
15 This wisdom is not that which comes
down from above, but is earthly, sensual,
and demonic.
16 For where jealousy and selfish
ambition are, there is confusion and
every evil deed.
17 But the wisdom that is from above is
first pure, then peaceful, gentle,
reasonable, full of mercy and good fruits,
without partiality, and without hypocrisy.
18 Now the fruit of righteousness is
sown in peace by those who make peace.

4

1 Where do wars and fightings among
you come from? Don't they come from
your pleasures that war in your
members?
2 You lust, and don't have. You murder
and covet, and can't obtain. You fight and
make war. You don't have, because you
don't ask.
3 You ask, and don't receive, because
you ask with wrong motives, so that you
may spend it on your pleasures.
4 You adulterers and adulteresses, don't
you know that friendship with the world
is hostility toward God? Whoever
therefore wants to be a friend of the
world makes himself an enemy of God.
5 Or do you think that the Scripture says
in vain, "The Spirit who lives in us yearns
jealously"?
6 But he gives more grace. Therefore it
says, "God resists the proud, but gives
grace to the humble."*
7 Be subject therefore to God. Resist the
devil, and he will flee from you.
8 Draw near to God, and he will draw
near to you. Cleanse your hands, you
sinners. Purify your hearts, you
double-minded.
9 Lament, mourn, and weep. Let your
laughter be turned to mourning and your
joy to gloom.
10 Humble yourselves in the sight of the
Lord, and he will exalt you.
11 Don't speak against one another,
brothers. He who speaks against a
brother and judges his brother, speaks
against the law and judges the law. But if
you judge the law, you are not a doer of
the law but a judge.
12 Only one is the lawgiver, who is able
to save and to destroy. But who are you to
judge another?
13 Come now, you who say, "Today or
tomorrow let's go into this city and spend
a year there, trade, and make a profit."
14 Yet you don't know what your life will
be like tomorrow. For what is your life?
For you are a vapor that appears for a
little time and then vanishes away.
15 For you ought to say, "If the Lord
wills, we will both live, and do this or
that."
16 But now you glory in your boasting.
All such boasting is evil.
17 To him therefore who knows to do
good and doesn't do it, to him it is sin.

5

1 Come now, you rich, weep and howl
for your miseries that are coming on you.
2 Your riches are corrupted and your
garments are moth-eaten.
3 Your gold and your silver are
corroded, and their corrosion will be for a

* **4:6** Proverbs 3:34

testimony against you and will eat your flesh like fire. You have laid up your treasure in the last days.
4 Behold, the wages of the laborers who mowed your fields, which you have kept back by fraud, cry out; and the cries of those who reaped have entered into the ears of the Lord of Armies.†
5 You have lived in luxury on the earth, and taken your pleasure. You have nourished your hearts as in a day of slaughter.
6 You have condemned and you have murdered the righteous one. He doesn't resist you.
7 Be patient therefore, brothers, until the coming of the Lord. Behold, the farmer waits for the precious fruit of the earth, being patient over it, until it receives the early and late rain.
8 You also be patient. Establish your hearts, for the coming of the Lord is at hand.
9 Don't grumble, brothers, against one another, so that you won't be judged. Behold, the judge stands at the door.
10 Take, brothers, for an example of suffering and of perseverance, the prophets who spoke in the name of the Lord.
11 Behold, we call them blessed who endured. You have heard of the perseverance of Job and have seen the Lord in the outcome, and how the Lord is full of compassion and mercy.
12 But above all things, my brothers, don't swear—not by heaven, or by the earth, or by any other oath; but let your "yes" be "yes", and your "no", "no", so that you don't fall into hypocrisy.‡
13 Is any among you suffering? Let him pray. Is any cheerful? Let him sing praises.
14 Is any among you sick? Let him call for the elders of the assembly, and let them pray over him, anointing him with oil in the name of the Lord;
15 and the prayer of faith will heal him who is sick, and the Lord will raise him up. If he has committed sins, he will be forgiven.
16 Confess your sins to one another and pray for one another, that you may be healed. The insistent prayer of a righteous person is powerfully effective.
17 Elijah was a man with a nature like ours, and he prayed earnestly that it might not rain, and it didn't rain on the earth for three years and six months.
18 He prayed again, and the sky gave rain, and the earth produced its fruit.
19 Brothers, if any among you wanders from the truth and someone turns him back,
20 let him know that he who turns a sinner from the error of his way will save a soul from death and will cover a multitude of sins.

† **5:4** Greek: Sabaoth (or Hebrew: Tze'va'ot) ‡ **5:12** TR reads "under judgment" instead of "into hypocrisy"

Peter's First Letter

1 Peter, an apostle of Jesus Christ,† to the
chosen ones who are living as foreigners
in the Dispersion in Pontus, Galatia,
Cappadocia, Asia, and Bithynia,
2 according to the foreknowledge of God
the Father, in sanctification of the Spirit,
that you may obey Jesus Christ and be
sprinkled with his blood: Grace to you
and peace be multiplied.
3 Blessed be the God and Father of our
Lord Jesus Christ, who according to his
great mercy caused us to be born again to
a living hope through the resurrection of
Jesus Christ from the dead,
4 to an incorruptible and undefiled
inheritance that doesn't fade away,
reserved in Heaven for you,
5 who by the power of God are guarded
through faith for a salvation ready to be
revealed in the last time.
6 In this you greatly rejoice, though now
for a little while, if need be, you have been
grieved in various trials,
7 that the proof of your faith, which is
more precious than gold that perishes,
even though it is tested by fire, may be
found to result in praise, glory, and honor
at the revelation of Jesus Christ—
8 whom, not having known, you love. In
him, though now you don't see him, yet
believing, you rejoice greatly with joy that
is unspeakable and full of glory,
9 receiving the result of your faith, the
salvation of your souls.
10 Concerning this salvation, the
prophets sought and searched diligently.
They prophesied of the grace that would
come to you,
11 searching for who or what kind of
time the Spirit of Christ which was in
them pointed to when he predicted the
sufferings of Christ and the glories that
would follow them.
12 To them it was revealed that they
served not themselves, but you, in these
things, which now have been announced
to you through those who preached the
Good News to you by the Holy Spirit sent
out from heaven; which things angels
desire to look into.
13 Therefore prepare your minds for
action.‡ Be sober, and set your hope fully
on the grace that will be brought to you at
the revelation of Jesus Christ—
14 as children of obedience, not
conforming yourselves according to your
former lusts as in your ignorance,
15 but just as he who called you is holy,
you yourselves also be holy in all of your
behavior,
16 because it is written, "You shall be
holy, for I am holy."*
17 If you call on him as Father, who
without respect of persons judges
according to each man's work, pass the
time of your living as foreigners here in
reverent fear,
18 knowing that you were redeemed,
not with corruptible things like silver or
gold, from the useless way of life handed
down from your fathers,
19 but with precious blood, as of a lamb
without blemish or spot, the blood of
Christ,
20 who was foreknown indeed before
the foundation of the world, but was
revealed in this last age for your sake,
21 who through him are believers in
God, who raised him from the dead and
gave him glory, so that your faith and
hope might be in God.
22 Seeing you have purified your souls
in your obedience to the truth through the
Spirit in sincere brotherly affection, love
one another from the heart fervently,
23 having been born again, not of
corruptible seed, but of incorruptible,
through the word of God, which lives and
remains forever.
24 For,
"All flesh is like grass,
and all of man's glory like the flower
in the grass.
The grass withers, and its flower falls;

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:13** literally, "gird up the waist of your mind" or "put on the belt of the waist of your mind" * **1:16** Leviticus 11:44-45 * **1:25** Isaiah 40:6-8

25 but the Lord's word endures
forever."*
This is the word of Good News which was preached to you.

2

1 Putting away therefore all wickedness, all deceit, hypocrisies, envies, and all evil speaking,
2 as newborn babies, long for the pure spiritual milk, that with it you may grow,
3 if indeed you have tasted that the Lord is gracious.
4 Come to him, a living stone, rejected indeed by men, but chosen by God, precious.
5 You also as living stones are built up as a spiritual house, to be a holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices, acceptable to God through Jesus Christ.
6 Because it is contained in Scripture,
"Behold,† I lay in Zion a chief cornerstone,
chosen and precious.
He who believes in him will not be
disappointed."*
7 For you who believe therefore is the honor, but for those who are disobedient,
"The stone which the builders rejected
has become the chief cornerstone,"*
8 and,
"a stumbling stone and a rock of offense."*
For they stumble at the word, being disobedient, to which also they were appointed.
9 But you are a chosen race, a royal priesthood, a holy nation, a people for God's own possession, that you may proclaim the excellence of him who called you out of darkness into his marvelous light.
10 In the past, you were not a people, but now are God's people, who had not obtained mercy, but now have obtained mercy.
11 Beloved, I beg you as foreigners and pilgrims to abstain from fleshly lusts which war against the soul,
12 having good behavior among the nations, so in that of which they speak against you as evildoers, they may see your good works and glorify God in the day of visitation.
13 Therefore subject yourselves to every ordinance of man for the Lord's sake: whether to the king, as supreme,
14 or to governors, as sent by him for vengeance on evildoers and for praise to those who do well.
15 For this is the will of God, that by well-doing you should put to silence the ignorance of foolish men.
16 Live as free people, yet not using your freedom for a cloak of wickedness, but as bondservants of God.
17 Honor all men. Love the brotherhood. Fear God. Honor the king.
18 Servants, be in subjection to your masters with all respect, not only to the good and gentle, but also to the wicked.
19 For it is commendable if someone endures pain, suffering unjustly, because of conscience toward God.
20 For what glory is it if, when you sin, you patiently endure beating? But if when you do well, you patiently endure suffering, this is commendable with God.
21 For you were called to this, because Christ also suffered for us, leaving you‡ an example, that you should follow his steps,
22 who didn't sin, "neither was deceit found in his mouth."*
23 When he was cursed, he didn't curse back. When he suffered, he didn't threaten, but committed himself to him who judges righteously.
24 He himself bore our sins in his body on the tree, that we, having died to sins, might live to righteousness. You were healed by his wounds.§
25 For you were going astray like sheep; but now you have returned to the Shepherd and Overseer† of your souls.

3

1 In the same way, wives, be in

† **2:6** "Behold", from "הִנֵּה" or "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. * **2:6** Isaiah 28:16 * **2:7** Psalms 118:22 * **2:8** Isaiah 8:14 ‡ **2:21** TR reads "us" instead of "you" * **2:22** Isaiah 53:9 § **2:24** or, stripes † **2:25** "Overseer" is from the Greek ἐπίσκοπον, which can mean overseer, curator, guardian, or superintendent.

subjection to your own husbands, so that,
even if any don't obey the Word, they may
be won by the behavior of their wives
without a word,
2 seeing your pure behavior in fear.
3 Let your beauty come not from the
outward adorning of braiding your hair,
and of wearing gold ornaments or of
putting on fine clothing,
4 but from the hidden person of the
heart, in the incorruptible adornment of a
gentle and quiet spirit, which is very
precious in God's sight.
5 For this is how in the past the holy
women who hoped in God also adorned
themselves, being in subjection to their
own husbands.
6 So Sarah obeyed Abraham, calling him
lord, whose children you now are if you
do well and are not put in fear by any
terror.
7 You husbands, in the same way, live
with your wives according to knowledge,
giving honor to the woman as to the
weaker vessel, as also being joint heirs of
the grace of life, that your prayers may
not be hindered.
8 Finally, all of you be like-minded,
compassionate, loving as brothers,
tenderhearted, courteous,
9 not rendering evil for evil or insult for
insult; but instead blessing, knowing that
you were called to this, that you may
inherit a blessing.
10 For,
"He who would love life
and see good days,
let him keep his tongue from evil
and his lips from speaking deceit.
11 Let him turn away from evil and do
good.
Let him seek peace and pursue it.
12 For the eyes of the Lord are on the
righteous,
and his ears open to their prayer;
but the face of the Lord is against
those who do evil."*
13 Now who will harm you if you
become imitators of that which is good?
14 But even if you should suffer for
righteousness' sake, you are blessed.
"Don't fear what they fear, neither be
troubled."*
15 But sanctify the Lord God in your
hearts. Always be ready to give an answer
to everyone who asks you a reason
concerning the hope that is in you, with
humility and fear,
16 having a good conscience. Thus,
while you are spoken against as evildoers,
they may be disappointed who curse your
good way of life in Christ.
17 For it is better, if it is God's will, that
you suffer for doing what is right than for
doing evil.
18 Because Christ also suffered for sins
once, the righteous for the unrighteous,
that he might bring you to God, being put
to death in the flesh, but made alive in the
Spirit,
19 in whom he also went and preached
to the spirits in prison,
20 who before were disobedient when
God waited patiently in the days of Noah
while the ship was being built. In it, few,
that is, eight souls, were saved through
water.
21 This is a symbol of baptism, which
now saves you—not the putting away of
the filth of the flesh, but the answer of a
good conscience toward God—through the
resurrection of Jesus Christ,
22 who is at the right hand of God,
having gone into heaven, angels and
authorities and powers being made
subject to him.

4

1 Therefore, since Christ suffered for us
in the flesh, arm yourselves also with the
same mind; for he who has suffered in the
flesh has ceased from sin,
2 that you no longer should live the rest
of your time in the flesh for the lusts of
men, but for the will of God.
3 For we have spent enough of our past
time doing the desire of the Gentiles, and
having walked in lewdness, lusts,

* **3:12** Psalms 34:12-16 * **3:14** Isaiah 8:12

drunken binges, orgies, carousings, and abominable idolatries.
4 They think it is strange that you don't
run with them into the same excess of
riot, speaking evil of you.
5 They will give account to him who is
ready to judge the living and the dead.
6 For to this end the Good News was
preached even to the dead, that they
might be judged indeed as men in the
flesh, but live as to God in the spirit.
7 But the end of all things is near.
Therefore be of sound mind,
self-controlled, and sober in prayer.
8 And above all things be earnest in
your love among yourselves, for love
covers a multitude of sins.
9 Be hospitable to one another without
grumbling.
10 As each has received a gift, employ it
in serving one another, as good managers
of the grace of God in its various forms.
11 If anyone speaks, let it be as it were
the very words of God. If anyone serves,
let it be as of the strength which God
supplies, that in all things God may be
glorified through Jesus Christ, to whom
belong the glory and the dominion
forever and ever. Amen.
12 Beloved, don't be astonished at the
fiery trial which has come upon you to
test you, as though a strange thing
happened to you.
13 But because you are partakers of
Christ's sufferings, rejoice, that at the
revelation of his glory you also may
rejoice with exceeding joy.
14 If you are insulted for the name of
Christ, you are blessed, because the Spirit
of glory and of God rests on you. On their
part he is blasphemed, but on your part
he is glorified.
15 But let none of you suffer as a
murderer, or a thief, or an evil doer, or a
meddler in other men's matters.
16 But if one of you suffers for being a
Christian, let him not be ashamed; but let
him glorify God in this matter.
17 For the time has come for judgment to
begin with the household of God. If it
begins first with us, what will happen to
those who don't obey the Good News of
God?
18 "If it is hard for the righteous to be
saved, what will happen to the ungodly
and the sinner?"*
19 Therefore let them also who suffer
according to the will of God in doing good
entrust their souls to him, as to a faithful
Creator.

5

1 Therefore I exhort the elders among
you, as a fellow elder and a witness of the
sufferings of Christ, and who will also
share in the glory that will be revealed:
2 shepherd the flock of God which is
among you, exercising the oversight, not
under compulsion, but voluntarily; not
for dishonest gain, but willingly;
3 not as lording it over those entrusted
to you, but making yourselves examples
to the flock.
4 When the chief Shepherd is revealed,
you will receive the crown of glory that
doesn't fade away.
5 Likewise, you younger ones, be subject
to the elder. Yes, all of you clothe
yourselves with humility and subject
yourselves to one another; for "God
resists the proud, but gives grace to the
humble."*
6 Humble yourselves therefore under
the mighty hand of God, that he may exalt
you in due time,
7 casting all your worries on him,
because he cares for you.
8 Be sober and self-controlled. Be
watchful. Your adversary, the devil, walks
around like a roaring lion, seeking whom
he may devour.
9 Withstand him steadfast in your faith,
knowing that your brothers who are in
the world are undergoing the same
sufferings.
10 But may the God of all grace, who
called you to his eternal glory by Christ
Jesus, after you have suffered a little
while, perfect, establish, strengthen, and
settle you.

* **4:18** Proverbs 11:31 * **5:5** Proverbs 3:34

11 To him be the glory and the power
forever and ever. Amen.
12 Through Silvanus, our faithful
brother, as I consider him, I have written
to you briefly, exhorting and testifying
that this is the true grace of God in which
you stand.
13 She who is in Babylon, chosen
together with you, greets you. So does
Mark, my son.
14 Greet one another with a kiss of love.
Peace be to all of you who are in Christ
Jesus. Amen.

Peter's Second Letter

1 Simon Peter, a servant and apostle of
Jesus Christ,† to those who have obtained
a like precious faith with us in the
righteousness of our God and Savior,
Jesus Christ:
2 Grace to you and peace be multiplied
in the knowledge of God and of Jesus our
Lord,
3 seeing that his divine power has
granted to us all things that pertain to life
and godliness, through the knowledge of
him who called us by his own glory and
virtue,
4 by which he has granted to us his
precious and exceedingly great promises;
that through these you may become
partakers of the divine nature, having
escaped from the corruption that is in the
world by lust.
5 Yes, and for this very cause adding on
your part all diligence, in your faith
supply moral excellence; and in moral
excellence, knowledge;
6 and in knowledge, self-control; and in
self-control, perseverance; and in
perseverance, godliness;
7 and in godliness, brotherly affection;
and in brotherly affection, love.
8 For if these things are yours and
abound, they make you to not be idle or
unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord
Jesus Christ.
9 For he who lacks these things is blind,
seeing only what is near, having forgotten
the cleansing from his old sins.
10 Therefore, brothers,‡ be more diligent
to make your calling and election sure.
For if you do these things, you will never
stumble.
11 For thus you will be richly supplied
with the entrance into the eternal
Kingdom of our Lord and Savior, Jesus
Christ.
12 Therefore I will not be negligent to
remind you of these things, though you
know them and are established in the
present truth.
13 I think it right, as long as I am in this
tent, to stir you up by reminding you,
14 knowing that the putting off of my
tent comes swiftly, even as our Lord Jesus
Christ made clear to me.
15 Yes, I will make every effort that you
may always be able to remember these
things even after my departure.
16 For we didn't follow cunningly
devised fables when we made known to
you the power and coming of our Lord
Jesus Christ, but we were eyewitnesses of
his majesty.
17 For he received from God the Father
honor and glory when the voice came to
him from the Majestic Glory, "This is my
beloved Son, in whom I am well pleased."*
18 We heard this voice come out of
heaven when we were with him on the
holy mountain.
19 We have the more sure word of
prophecy; and you do well that you heed
it as to a lamp shining in a dark place,
until the day dawns and the morning star
arises in your hearts,
20 knowing this first, that no prophecy
of Scripture is of private interpretation.
21 For no prophecy ever came by the
will of man, but holy men of God spoke,
being moved by the Holy Spirit.

2

1 But false prophets also arose among
the people, as false teachers will also be
among you, who will secretly bring in
destructive heresies, denying even the
Master who bought them, bringing on
themselves swift destruction.
2 Many will follow their immoral† ways,
and as a result, the way of the truth will be
maligned.
3 In covetousness they will exploit you
with deceptive words: whose sentence

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:10** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings." * **1:17** Matthew 17:5; Mark 9:7; Luke 9:35 † **2:2** TR reads "destructive" instead of "immoral" ‡ **2:4** Tartarus is another name for Hell

now from of old doesn't linger, and their destruction will not slumber.
4 For if God didn't spare angels when they sinned, but cast them down to Tartarus,‡ and committed them to pits of darkness to be reserved for judgment;
5 and didn't spare the ancient world, but preserved Noah with seven others, a preacher of righteousness, when he brought a flood on the world of the ungodly,
6 and turning the cities of Sodom and Gomorrah into ashes, condemned them to destruction, having made them an example to those who would live in an ungodly way,
7 and delivered righteous Lot, who was very distressed by the lustful life of the wicked
8 (for that righteous man dwelling among them was tormented in his righteous soul from day to day with seeing and hearing lawless deeds),
9 then the Lord knows how to deliver the godly out of temptation and to keep the unrighteous under punishment for the day of judgment,
10 but chiefly those who walk after the flesh in the lust of defilement and despise authority. Daring, self-willed, they are not afraid to speak evil of dignitaries,
11 whereas angels, though greater in might and power, don't bring a slanderous judgment against them before the Lord.
12 But these, as unreasoning creatures, born natural animals to be taken and destroyed, speaking evil in matters about which they are ignorant, will in their destroying surely be destroyed,
13 receiving the wages of unrighteousness; people who count it pleasure to revel in the daytime, spots and defects, reveling in their deceit while they feast with you;
14 having eyes full of adultery, and who can't cease from sin, enticing unsettled souls, having a heart trained in greed, accursed children!
15 Forsaking the right way, they went astray, having followed the way of Balaam the son of Beor, who loved the wages of wrongdoing;
16 but he was rebuked for his own disobedience. A speechless donkey spoke with a man's voice and stopped the madness of the prophet.
17 These are wells without water, clouds driven by a storm, for whom the blackness of darkness has been reserved forever.
18 For, uttering great swelling words of emptiness, they entice in the lusts of the flesh, by licentiousness, those who are indeed escaping from those who live in error;
19 promising them liberty, while they themselves are bondservants of corruption; for a man is brought into bondage by whoever overcomes him.
20 For if, after they have escaped the defilement of the world through the knowledge of the Lord and Savior Jesus Christ, they are again entangled in it and overcome, the last state has become worse for them than the first.
21 For it would be better for them not to have known the way of righteousness, than after knowing it, to turn back from the holy commandment delivered to them.
22 But it has happened to them according to the true proverb, "The dog turns to his own vomit again,"* and "the sow that has washed to wallowing in the mire."

3

1 This is now, beloved, the second letter that I have written to you; and in both of them I stir up your sincere mind by reminding you
2 that you should remember the words which were spoken before by the holy prophets and the commandment of us, the apostles of the Lord and Savior,
3 knowing this first, that in the last days mockers will come, walking after their own lusts
4 and saying, "Where is the promise of his coming? For, from the day that the

* **2:22** Proverbs 26:11

fathers fell asleep, all things continue as
they were from the beginning of the
creation."
5 For they willfully forget that there
were heavens from of old, and an earth
formed out of water and amid water by
the word of God,
6 by which means the world that existed
then, being overflowed with water,
perished.
7 But the heavens that exist now and the
earth, by the same word have been stored
up for fire, being reserved against the day
of judgment and destruction of ungodly
men.
8 But don't forget this one thing,
beloved, that one day is with the Lord as a
thousand years, and a thousand years as
one day.
9 The Lord is not slow concerning his
promise, as some count slowness; but he
is patient with us, not wishing that
anyone should perish, but that all should
come to repentance.
10 But the day of the Lord will come as a
thief in the night, in which the heavens
will pass away with a great noise, and the
elements will be dissolved with fervent
heat; and the earth and the works that are
in it will be burned up.
11 Therefore, since all these things will
be destroyed like this, what kind of people
ought you to be in holy living and
godliness,
12 looking for and earnestly desiring the
coming of the day of God, which will cause
the burning heavens to be dissolved, and
the elements will melt with fervent heat?
13 But, according to his promise, we look
for new heavens and a new earth, in
which righteousness dwells.
14 Therefore, beloved, seeing that you
look for these things, be diligent to be
found in peace, without defect and
blameless in his sight.
15 Regard the patience of our Lord as
salvation; even as our beloved brother
Paul also, according to the wisdom given
to him, wrote to you,
16 as also in all of his letters, speaking in
them of these things. In those, there are
some things that are hard to understand,
which the ignorant and unsettled twist, as
they also do to the other Scriptures, to
their own destruction.
17 You therefore, beloved, knowing
these things beforehand, beware, lest
being carried away with the error of the
wicked, you fall from your own
steadfastness.
18 But grow in the grace and knowledge
of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. To
him be the glory both now and forever.
Amen.

John's First Letter

1 That which was from the beginning,
that which we have heard, that which we
have seen with our eyes, that which we
saw, and our hands touched, concerning
the Word of life
2 (and the life was revealed, and we
have seen, and testify, and declare to you
the life, the eternal life, which was with
the Father, and was revealed to us);
3 that which we have seen and heard we
declare to you, that you also may have
fellowship with us. Yes, and our
fellowship is with the Father and with his
Son, Jesus Christ.†
4 And we write these things to you, that
our joy may be fulfilled.
5 This is the message which we have
heard from him and announce to you,
that God is light, and in him is no darkness
at all.
6 If we say that we have fellowship with
him and walk in the darkness, we lie and
don't tell the truth.
7 But if we walk in the light as he is in
the light, we have fellowship with one
another, and the blood of Jesus Christ his
Son cleanses us from all sin.
8 If we say that we have no sin, we
deceive ourselves, and the truth is not in
us.
9 If we confess our sins, he is faithful
and righteous to forgive us the sins and to
cleanse us from all unrighteousness.
10 If we say that we haven't sinned, we
make him a liar, and his word is not in us.

2

1 My little children, I write these things
to you so that you may not sin. If anyone
sins, we have a Counselor† with the
Father, Jesus Christ, the righteous.
2 And he is the atoning sacrifice‡ for our
sins, and not for ours only, but also for the
whole world.
3 This is how we know that we know
him: if we keep his commandments.
4 One who says, "I know him," and
doesn't keep his commandments, is a liar,
and the truth isn't in him.
5 But God's love has most certainly been
perfected in whoever keeps his word.
This is how we know that we are in him:
6 he who says he remains in him ought
himself also to walk just like he walked.
7 Brothers, I write no new
commandment to you, but an old
commandment which you had from the
beginning. The old commandment is the
word which you heard from the
beginning.
8 Again, I write a new commandment to
you, which is true in him and in you,
because the darkness is passing away and
the true light already shines.
9 He who says he is in the light and hates
his brother is in the darkness even until
now.
10 He who loves his brother remains in
the light, and there is no occasion for
stumbling in him.
11 But he who hates his brother is in the
darkness, and walks in the darkness, and
doesn't know where he is going, because
the darkness has blinded his eyes.
12 I write to you, little children, because
your sins are forgiven you for his name's
sake.
13 I write to you, fathers, because you
know him who is from the beginning.
I write to you, young men, because you
have overcome the evil one.
I write to you, little children, because
you know the Father.
14 I have written to you, fathers, because
you know him who is from the beginning.
I have written to you, young men,
because you are strong, and the word of
God remains in you, and you have
overcome the evil one.
15 Don't love the world or the things that
are in the world. If anyone loves the
world, the Father's love isn't in him.

† **1:3** "Christ" means "Anointed One". † **2:1** Greek παρακλητον: Counselor, Helper, Intercessor, Advocate, and Comforter. ‡ **2:2** "atoning sacrifice" is from the Greek "ιλασμος", an appeasing, propitiating, or the means of appeasement or propitiation—the sacrifice that turns away God's wrath because of our sin.

16 For all that is in the world—the lust of
the flesh, the lust of the eyes, and the pride
of life—isn't the Father's, but is the world's.
17 The world is passing away with its
lusts, but he who does God's will remains
forever.
18 Little children, these are the end
times, and as you heard that the
Antichrist is coming, even now many
antichrists have arisen. By this we know
that it is the final hour.
19 They went out from us, but they didn't
belong to us; for if they had belonged to
us, they would have continued with us.
But they left, that they might be revealed
that none of them belong to us.
20 You have an anointing from the Holy
One, and you all have knowledge.§
21 I have not written to you because you
don't know the truth, but because you
know it, and because no lie is of the truth.
22 Who is the liar but he who denies that
Jesus is the Christ? This is the Antichrist,
he who denies the Father and the Son.
23 Whoever denies the Son doesn't have
the Father. He who confesses the Son has
the Father also.†
24 Therefore, as for you, let that remain
in you which you heard from the
beginning. If that which you heard from
the beginning remains in you, you also
will remain in the Son, and in the Father.
25 This is the promise which he
promised us, the eternal life.
26 These things I have written to you
concerning those who would lead you
astray.
27 As for you, the anointing which you
received from him remains in you, and
you don't need for anyone to teach you.
But as his anointing teaches you
concerning all things, and is true, and is
no lie, and even as it taught you, you will
remain in him.
28 Now, little children, remain in him,
that when he appears, we may have
boldness and not be ashamed before him
at his coming.
29 If you know that he is righteous, you
know that everyone who practices
righteousness has been born of him.

3

1 See how great a love the Father has
given to us, that we should be called
children of God! For this cause the world
doesn't know us, because it didn't know
him.
2 Beloved, now we are children of God.
It is not yet revealed what we will be; but
we know that when he is revealed, we will
be like him, for we will see him just as he
is.
3 Everyone who has this hope set on him
purifies himself, even as he is pure.
4 Everyone who sins also commits
lawlessness. Sin is lawlessness.
5 You know that he was revealed to take
away our sins, and no sin is in him.
6 Whoever remains in him doesn't sin.
Whoever sins hasn't seen him and doesn't
know him.
7 Little children, let no one lead you
astray. He who does righteousness is
righteous, even as he is righteous.
8 He who sins is of the devil, for the devil
has been sinning from the beginning. To
this end the Son of God was revealed: that
he might destroy the works of the devil.
9 Whoever is born of God doesn't
commit sin, because his seed remains in
him, and he can't sin, because he is born
of God.
10 In this the children of God are
revealed, and the children of the devil.
Whoever doesn't do righteousness is not
of God, neither is he who doesn't love his
brother.
11 For this is the message which you
heard from the beginning, that we should
love one another—
12 unlike Cain, who was of the evil one
and killed his brother. Why did he kill
him? Because his deeds were evil, and his
brother's righteous.
13 Don't be surprised, my brothers, if the
world hates you.
14 We know that we have passed out of
death into life, because we love the
brothers. He who doesn't love his brother
remains in death.

§ **2:20** Or, "know what is true", or, "know all things"

† **2:23** MT omits: He who confesses the Son has the Father also.

15 Whoever hates his brother is a
murderer, and you know that no
murderer has eternal life remaining in
him.
16 By this we know love, because he laid
down his life for us. And we ought to lay
down our lives for the brothers.
17 But whoever has the world's goods
and sees his brother in need, then closes
his heart of compassion against him, how
does God's love remain in him?
18 My little children, let's not love in
word only, or with the tongue only, but in
deed and truth.
19 And by this we know that we are of
the truth and persuade our hearts before
him,
20 because if our heart condemns us,
God is greater than our heart, and knows
all things.
21 Beloved, if our hearts don't condemn
us, we have boldness toward God;
22 so whatever we ask, we receive from
him, because we keep his commandments
and do the things that are pleasing in his
sight.
23 This is his commandment, that we
should believe in the name of his Son,
Jesus Christ, and love one another, even
as he commanded.
24 He who keeps his commandments
remains in him, and he in him. By this we
know that he remains in us, by the Spirit
which he gave us.

4

1 Beloved, don't believe every spirit, but
test the spirits, whether they are of God,
because many false prophets have gone
out into the world.
2 By this you know the Spirit of God:
every spirit who confesses that Jesus
Christ has come in the flesh is of God,
3 and every spirit who doesn't confess
that Jesus Christ has come in the flesh is
not of God; and this is the spirit of the
Antichrist, of whom you have heard that
it comes. Now it is in the world already.
4 You are of God, little children, and
have overcome them, because greater is
he who is in you than he who is in the
world.
5 They are of the world. Therefore they
speak of the world, and the world hears
them.
6 We are of God. He who knows God
listens to us. He who is not of God doesn't
listen to us. By this we know the spirit of
truth, and the spirit of error.

7 Beloved, let's love one another, for
love is of God; and everyone who loves
has been born of God and knows God.
8 He who doesn't love doesn't know God,
for God is love.
9 By this God's love was revealed in us,
that God has sent his only born† Son into
the world that we might live through him.
10 In this is love, not that we loved God,
but that he loved us, and sent his Son as
the atoning sacrifice‡ for our sins.
11 Beloved, if God loved us in this way,
we also ought to love one another.
12 No one has seen God at any time. If
we love one another, God remains in us,
and his love has been perfected in us.

13 By this we know that we remain in
him and he in us, because he has given us
of his Spirit.
14 We have seen and testify that the
Father has sent the Son as the Savior of
the world.
15 Whoever confesses that Jesus is the
Son of God, God remains in him, and he in
God.
16 We know and have believed the love
which God has for us. God is love, and he
who remains in love remains in God, and
God remains in him.
17 In this, love has been made perfect
among us, that we may have boldness in
the day of judgment, because as he is,
even so we are in this world.
18 There is no fear in love; but perfect
love casts out fear, because fear has
punishment. He who fears is not made
perfect in love.

† **4:9** The phrase "only born" is from the Greek word "μονογενη", which is sometimes translated "only begotten" or "one and only". ‡ **4:10** "atoning sacrifice" is from the Greek "ιλασμος", an appeasing, propitiating, or the means of appeasement or propitiation—the sacrifice that turns away God's wrath because of our sin. § **4:19** NU omits "him".

19 We love him,§ because he first loved
us.
20 If a man says, “I love God,” and hates
his brother, he is a liar; for he who doesn’t
love his brother whom he has seen, how
can he love God whom he has not seen?
21 This commandment we have from
him, that he who loves God should also
love his brother.

5

1 Whoever believes that Jesus is the
Christ has been born of God. Whoever
loves the Father also loves the child who is
born of him.
2 By this we know that we love the
children of God, when we love God and
keep his commandments.
3 For this is loving God, that we keep his
commandments. His commandments are
not grievous.
4 For whatever is born of God
overcomes the world. This is the victory
that has overcome the world: your faith.
5 Who is he who overcomes the world,
but he who believes that Jesus is the Son
of God?
6 This is he who came by water and
blood, Jesus Christ; not with the water
only, but with the water and the blood. It
is the Spirit who testifies, because the
Spirit is the truth.
7 For there are three who testify:†
8 the Spirit, the water, and the blood;
and the three agree as one.
9 If we receive the witness of men, the
witness of God is greater; for this is God’s
testimony which he has testified
concerning his Son.
10 He who believes in the Son of God has
the testimony in himself. He who doesn’t
believe God has made him a liar, because
he has not believed in the testimony that
God has given concerning his Son.
11 The testimony is this: that God gave to
us eternal life, and this life is in his Son.
12 He who has the Son has the life. He
who doesn’t have God’s Son doesn’t have
the life.
13 These things I have written to you
who believe in the name of the Son of
God, that you may know that you have
eternal life, and that you may continue to
believe in the name of the Son of God.
14 This is the boldness which we have
toward him, that if we ask anything
according to his will, he listens to us.
15 And if we know that he listens to us,
whatever we ask, we know that we have
the petitions which we have asked of him.
16 If anyone sees his brother sinning a
sin not leading to death, he shall ask, and
God will give him life for those who sin
not leading to death. There is sin leading
to death. I don’t say that he should make a
request concerning this.
17 All unrighteousness is sin, and there
is sin not leading to death.
18 We know that whoever is born of God
doesn’t sin, but he who was born of God
keeps himself, and the evil one doesn’t
touch him.
19 We know that we are of God, and the
whole world lies in the power of the evil
one.
20 We know that the Son of God has
come and has given us an understanding,
that we know him who is true; and we are
in him who is true, in his Son Jesus Christ.
This is the true God and eternal life.
21 Little children, keep yourselves from
idols.

† **5:7** Only a few recent manuscripts add “in heaven: the Father, the Word, and the Holy Spirit; and these three are one. And there are three that testify on earth:”

John's Second Letter

1 The elder, to the chosen lady and her
children, whom I love in truth, and not I
only, but also all those who know the
truth,
2 for the truth's sake, which remains in
us, and it will be with us forever:
3 Grace, mercy, and peace will be with
us, from God the Father and from the
Lord Jesus Christ,† the Son of the Father,
in truth and love.
4 I rejoice greatly that I have found some
of your children walking in truth, even as
we have been commanded by the Father.
5 Now I beg you, dear lady, not as though
I wrote to you a new commandment, but
that which we had from the beginning,
that we love one another.
6 This is love, that we should walk
according to his commandments. This is
the commandment, even as you heard
from the beginning, that you should walk
in it.
7 For many deceivers have gone out into
the world, those who don't confess that
Jesus Christ came in the flesh. This is the
deceiver and the Antichrist.
8 Watch yourselves, that we don't lose
the things which we have accomplished,
but that we receive a full reward.
9 Whoever transgresses and doesn't
remain in the teaching of Christ doesn't
have God. He who remains in the
teaching has both the Father and the Son.
10 If anyone comes to you and doesn't
bring this teaching, don't receive him into
your house, and don't welcome him,
11 for he who welcomes him
participates in his evil deeds.
12 Having many things to write to you, I
don't want to do so with paper and ink,
but I hope to come to you and to speak
face to face, that our joy may be made full.
13 The children of your chosen sister
greet you. Amen.

† **1:3** "Christ" means "Anointed One".

John’s Third Letter

1 The elder to Gaius the beloved, whom I
love in truth.
2 Beloved, I pray that you may prosper
in all things and be healthy, even as your
soul prospers.
3 For I rejoiced greatly when brothers
came and testified about your truth, even
as you walk in truth.
4 I have no greater joy than this: to hear
about my children walking in truth.
5 Beloved, you do a faithful work in
whatever you accomplish for those who
are brothers and strangers.
6 They have testified about your love
before the assembly. You will do well to
send them forward on their journey in a
way worthy of God,
7 because for the sake of the Name they
went out, taking nothing from the
Gentiles.
8 We therefore ought to receive such,
that we may be fellow workers for the
truth.
9 I wrote to the assembly, but
Diotrephes, who loves to be first among
them, doesn’t accept what we say.
10 Therefore, if I come, I will call
attention to his deeds which he does,
unjustly accusing us with wicked words.
Not content with this, he doesn’t receive
the brothers himself, and those who
would, he forbids and throws out of the
assembly.
11 Beloved, don’t imitate that which is
evil, but that which is good. He who does
good is of God. He who does evil hasn’t
seen God.
12 Demetrius has the testimony of all,
and of the truth itself; yes, we also testify,
and you know that our testimony is true.
13 I had many things to write to you, but
I am unwilling to write to you with ink
and pen;
14 but I hope to see you soon. Then we
will speak face to face.
Peace be to you. The friends greet you.
Greet the friends by name.

The Letter from Jude

1 Jude,† a servant of Jesus Christ,‡ and
brother of James, to those who are called,
sanctified by God the Father, and kept for
Jesus Christ:
2 May mercy, peace, and love be
multiplied to you.
3 Beloved, while I was very eager to
write to you about our common salvation,
I was constrained to write to you
exhorting you to contend earnestly for the
faith which was once for all delivered to
the saints.
4 For there are certain men who crept in
secretly, even those who were long ago
written about for this condemnation:
ungodly men, turning the grace of our
God into indecency, and denying our only
Master, God, and Lord, Jesus Christ.
5 Now I desire to remind you, though
you already know this, that the Lord,
having saved a people out of the land of
Egypt, afterward destroyed those who
didn't believe.
6 Angels who didn't keep their first
domain, but deserted their own dwelling
place, he has kept in everlasting bonds
under darkness for the judgment of the
great day.
7 Even as Sodom and Gomorrah and the
cities around them, having in the same
way as these given themselves over to
sexual immorality and gone after strange
flesh, are shown as an example, suffering
the punishment of eternal fire.
8 Yet in the same way, these also in their
dreaming defile the flesh, despise
authority, and slander celestial beings.
9 But Michael, the archangel, when
contending with the devil and arguing
about the body of Moses, dared not bring
against him an abusive condemnation,
but said, "May the Lord rebuke you!"
10 But these speak evil of whatever
things they don't know. They are
destroyed in these things that they
understand naturally, like the creatures
without reason.
11 Woe to them! For they went in the
way of Cain, and ran riotously in the error
of Balaam for hire, and perished in
Korah's rebellion.
12 These are hidden rocky reefs in your
love feasts when they feast with you,
shepherds who without fear feed
themselves; clouds without water, carried
along by winds; autumn trees without
fruit, twice dead, plucked up by the roots;
13 wild waves of the sea, foaming out
their own shame; wandering stars, for
whom the blackness of darkness has been
reserved forever.
14 About these also Enoch, the seventh
from Adam, prophesied, saying, "Behold,§
the Lord came with ten thousands of his
holy ones,
15 to execute judgment on all, and to
convict all the ungodly of all their works
of ungodliness which they have done in
an ungodly way, and of all the hard things
which ungodly sinners have spoken
against him."
16 These are murmurers and
complainers, walking after their
lusts—and their mouth speaks proud
things—showing respect of persons to
gain advantage.
17 But you, beloved, remember the
words which have been spoken before by
the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ.
18 They said to you, "In the last time
there will be mockers, walking after their
own ungodly lusts."
19 These are those who cause divisions
and are sensual, not having the Spirit.
20 But you, beloved, keep building up
yourselves on your most holy faith,
praying in the Holy Spirit.
21 Keep yourselves in God's love, looking
for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ to
eternal life.
22 On some have compassion, making a
distinction,
23 and some save, snatching them out of
the fire with fear, hating even the clothing

† **1:1** or, Judah ‡ **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One".
§ **1:14** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection.

stained by the flesh.
24 Now to him who is able to keep them†
from stumbling, and to present you
faultless before the presence of his glory
in great joy,
25 to God our Savior, who alone is wise,
be glory and majesty, dominion and
power, both now and forever. Amen.

† **1:24** TR and NU read “you”

The Revelation to John

1 This is the Revelation of Jesus Christ,† which God gave him to show to his
servants the things which must happen
soon, which he sent and made known by
his angel‡ to his servant, John,
2 who testified to God's word and of the
testimony of Jesus Christ, about
everything that he saw.
3 Blessed is he who reads and those who
hear the words of the prophecy, and keep
the things that are written in it, for the
time is near.
4 John, to the seven assemblies that are
in Asia: Grace to you and peace from God,
who is and who was and who is to come;
and from the seven Spirits who are before
his throne;
5 and from Jesus Christ, the faithful
witness, the firstborn of the dead, and the
ruler of the kings of the earth. To him who
loves us, and washed us from our sins by
his blood—
6 and he made us to be a Kingdom,
priests* to his God and Father—to him be
the glory and the dominion forever and
ever. Amen.
7 Behold,§ he is coming with the clouds,
and every eye will see him, including
those who pierced him. All the tribes of
the earth will mourn over him. Even so,
Amen.
8 "I am the Alpha and the Omega,†" says
the Lord God,‡ "who is and who was and
who is to come, the Almighty."
9 I John, your brother and partner with
you in the oppression, Kingdom, and
perseverance in Christ Jesus, was on the
isle that is called Patmos because of God's
Word and the testimony of Jesus Christ.
10 I was in the Spirit on the Lord's day,
and I heard behind me a loud voice, like a
trumpet
11 saying,§ "What you see, write in a
book and send to the seven assemblies:†
to Ephesus, Smyrna, Pergamum, Thyatira,
Sardis, Philadelphia, and to Laodicea."
12 I turned to see the voice that spoke
with me. Having turned, I saw seven
golden lamp stands.
13 And among the lamp stands was one
like a son of man,* clothed with a robe
reaching down to his feet, and with a
golden sash around his chest.
14 His head and his hair were white as
white wool, like snow. His eyes were like
a flame of fire.
15 His feet were like burnished brass, as
if it had been refined in a furnace. His
voice was like the voice of many waters.
16 He had seven stars in his right hand.
Out of his mouth proceeded a sharp
two-edged sword. His face was like the
sun shining at its brightest.
17 When I saw him, I fell at his feet like a
dead man.
He laid his right hand on me, saying,
"Don't be afraid. I am the first and the last,
18 and the Living one. I was dead, and
behold, I am alive forever and ever.
Amen. I have the keys of Death and of
Hades.‡
19 Write therefore the things which you
have seen, and the things which are, and
the things which will happen hereafter.
20 The mystery of the seven stars which
you saw in my right hand, and the seven
golden lamp stands is this: The seven
stars are the angels§ of the seven
assemblies. The seven lamp stands are
seven assemblies.

2

1 "To the angel of the assembly in
Ephesus write:
"He who holds the seven stars in his
right hand, he who walks among the
seven golden lamp stands says these
things:

† **1:1** "Christ" means "Anointed One". ‡ **1:1** or, messenger (here and wherever angel is mentioned) * **1:6** Exodus 19:6; Isaiah 61:6 § **1:7** "Behold", from "ἰδοὺ", means look at, take notice, observe, see, or gaze at. It is often used as an interjection. † **1:8** TR adds "the Beginning and the End" ‡ **1:8** TR omits "God" § **1:11** TR adds "I am the Alpha and the Omega, the First and the Last." † **1:11** TR adds "which are in Asia" * **1:13** Daniel 7:13 ‡ **1:18** or, Hell § **1:20** or, messengers (here and wherever angels are mentioned)

2 “I know your works, and your toil and
perseverance, and that you can’t tolerate
evil men, and have tested those who call
themselves apostles, and they are not, and
found them false.
3 You have perseverance and have
endured for my name’s sake, and have †
not grown weary.
4 But I have this against you, that you
left your first love.
5 Remember therefore from where you
have fallen, and repent and do the first
works; or else I am coming to you swiftly,
and will move your lamp stand out of its
place, unless you repent.
6 But this you have, that you hate the
works of the Nicolaitans, which I also
hate.
7 He who has an ear, let him hear what
the Spirit says to the assemblies. To him
who overcomes I will give to eat from the
tree of life, which is in the Paradise of my
God.
8 “To the angel of the assembly in
Smyrna write:
“The first and the last, who was dead,
and has come to life says these things:
9 “I know your works, oppression, and
your poverty (but you are rich), and the
blasphemy of those who say they are
Jews, and they are not, but are a
synagogue of Satan.
10 Don’t be afraid of the things which
you are about to suffer. Behold, the devil
is about to throw some of you into prison,
that you may be tested; and you will have
oppression for ten days. Be faithful to
death, and I will give you the crown of life.

11 He who has an ear, let him hear what
the Spirit says to the assemblies. He who
overcomes won’t be harmed by the
second death.
12 “To the angel of the assembly in
Pergamum write:
“He who has the sharp two-edged
sword says these things:
13 “I know your works and where you
dwell, where Satan’s throne is. You hold
firmly to my name, and didn’t deny my
faith in the days of Antipas my witness,
my faithful one, who was killed among
you, where Satan dwells.
14 But I have a few things against you,
because you have there some who hold
the teaching of Balaam, who taught Balak
to throw a stumbling block before the
children of Israel, to eat things sacrificed
to idols, and to commit sexual immorality.

15 So also you likewise have some who
hold to the teaching of the Nicolaitans.‡
16 Repent therefore, or else I am coming
to you quickly and I will make war against
them with the sword of my mouth.
17 He who has an ear, let him hear what
the Spirit says to the assemblies. To him
who overcomes, to him I will give of the
hidden manna, § and I will give him a
white stone, and on the stone a new name
written which no one knows but he who
receives it.
18 “To the angel of the assembly in
Thyatira write:
“The Son of God, who has his eyes like a
flame of fire, and his feet are like
burnished brass, says these things:
19 “I know your works, your love, faith,
service, patient endurance, and that your
last works are more than the first.
20 But I have this against you, that you
tolerate your† woman Jezebel, who calls
herself a prophetess. She teaches and
seduces my servants to commit sexual
immorality and to eat things sacrificed to
idols.
21 I gave her time to repent, but she
refuses to repent of her sexual
immorality.
22 Behold, I will throw her and those
who commit adultery with her into a bed
of great oppression, unless they repent of
her works.
23 I will kill her children with Death, and
all the assemblies will know that I am he
who searches the minds and hearts. I will
give to each one of you according to your
deeds.

† **2:3** TR adds “have labored and” ‡ **2:15** TR reads “which I hate” instead of “likewise” § **2:17** Manna is supernatural food, named after the Hebrew for “What is it?”. See Exodus 11:7-9. † **2:20** TR, NU read “that” instead of “your”

24 But to you I say, to the rest who are in
Thyatira—as many as don't have this
teaching, who don't know what some call
'the deep things of Satan'—to you I say, I
am not putting any other burden on you.
25 Nevertheless, hold that which you
have firmly until I come.
26 He who overcomes, and he who keeps
my works to the end, to him I will give
authority over the nations.
27 He will rule them with a rod of iron,
shattering them like clay pots,* as I also
have received of my Father;
28 and I will give him the morning star.
29 He who has an ear, let him hear what
the Spirit says to the assemblies.

3

1 "And to the angel of the assembly in
Sardis write:
"He who has the seven Spirits of God
and the seven stars says these things:
"I know your works, that you have a
reputation of being alive, but you are
dead.
2 Wake up and strengthen the things
that remain, which you were about to
throw away,† for I have found no works of
yours perfected before my God.
3 Remember therefore how you have
received and heard. Keep it and repent. If
therefore you won't watch, I will come as
a thief, and you won't know what hour I
will come upon you.
4 Nevertheless you have a few names in
Sardis that didn't defile their garments.
They will walk with me in white, for they
are worthy.
5 He who overcomes will be arrayed in
white garments, and I will in no way blot
his name out of the book of life, and I will
confess his name before my Father, and
before his angels.
6 He who has an ear, let him hear what
the Spirit says to the assemblies.
7 "To the angel of the assembly in
Philadelphia write:
"He who is holy, he who is true, he who
has the key of David, he who opens and no
one can shut, and who shuts and no one
opens, says these things:
8 "I know your works (behold, I have set
before you an open door, which no one
can shut), that you have a little power, and
kept my word, and didn't deny my name.
9 Behold, I make some of the synagogue
of Satan, of those who say they are Jews,
and they are not, but lie—behold, I will
make them to come and worship before
your feet, and to know that I have loved
you.
10 Because you kept my command to
endure, I also will keep you from the hour
of testing which is to come on the whole
world, to test those who dwell on the
earth.
11 I am coming quickly! Hold firmly that
which you have, so that no one takes your
crown.
12 He who overcomes, I will make him a
pillar in the temple of my God, and he will
go out from there no more. I will write on
him the name of my God and the name of
the city of my God, the new Jerusalem,
which comes down out of heaven from
my God, and my own new name.
13 He who has an ear, let him hear what
the Spirit says to the assemblies.
14 "To the angel of the assembly in
Laodicea write:
"The Amen, the Faithful and True
Witness, the Beginning‡ of God's creation,
says these things:
15 "I know your works, that you are
neither cold nor hot. I wish you were cold
or hot.
16 So, because you are lukewarm, and
neither hot nor cold, I will vomit you out
of my mouth.
17 Because you say, 'I am rich, and have
gotten riches, and have need of nothing,'
and don't know that you are the wretched
one, miserable, poor, blind, and naked;
18 I counsel you to buy from me gold
refined by fire, that you may become rich;
and white garments, that you may clothe
yourself, and that the shame of your
nakedness may not be revealed; and eye

* **2:27** Psalms 2:9 † **3:2** NU & TR read "which were about to die" instead of "which you were about to throw away".
‡ **3:14** or, Source, or Head

salve to anoint your eyes, that you may see.
19 As many as I love, I reprove and
chasten. Be zealous therefore, and repent.

20 Behold, I stand at the door and knock.
If anyone hears my voice and opens the
door, then I will come in to him and will
dine with him, and he with me.
21 He who overcomes, I will give to him
to sit down with me on my throne, as I
also overcame and sat down with my
Father on his throne.
22 He who has an ear, let him hear what
the Spirit says to the assemblies."

4

1 After these things I looked and saw a
door opened in heaven; and the first voice
that I heard, like a trumpet speaking with
me, was one saying, "Come up here, and I
will show you the things which must
happen after this."
2 Immediately I was in the Spirit.
Behold, there was a throne set in heaven,
and one sitting on the throne
3 that looked like a jasper stone and a
sardius. There was a rainbow around the
throne, like an emerald to look at.
4 Around the throne were twenty-four
thrones. On the thrones were twenty-four
elders sitting, dressed in white garments,
with crowns of gold on their heads.
5 Out of the throne proceed lightnings,
sounds, and thunders. There were seven
lamps of fire burning before his throne,
which are the seven Spirits of God.
6 Before the throne was something like a
sea of glass, similar to crystal. In the
middle of the throne, and around the
throne were four living creatures full of
eyes before and behind.
7 The first creature was like a lion, the
second creature like a calf, the third
creature had a face like a man, and the
fourth was like a flying eagle.
8 The four living creatures, each one of
them having six wings, are full of eyes
around and within. They have no rest day
and night, saying, "Holy, holy, holy† is the
Lord God, the Almighty, who was and
who is and who is to come!"
9 When the living creatures give glory,
honor, and thanks to him who sits on the
throne, to him who lives forever and ever,
10 the twenty-four elders fall down
before him who sits on the throne and
worship him who lives forever and ever,
and throw their crowns before the throne,
saying,
11 "Worthy are you, our Lord and God,
the Holy One,‡ to receive the glory, the
honor, and the power, for you created all
things, and because of your desire they
existed and were created!"

5

1 I saw, in the right hand of him who sat
on the throne, a book written inside and
outside, sealed shut with seven seals.
2 I saw a mighty angel proclaiming with
a loud voice, "Who is worthy to open the
book, and to break its seals?"
3 No one in heaven above, or on the
earth, or under the earth, was able to
open the book or to look in it.
4 Then I wept much, because no one was
found worthy to open the book or to look
in it.
5 One of the elders said to me, "Don't
weep. Behold, the Lion who is of the tribe
of Judah, the Root of David, has overcome:
he who opens the book and its seven
seals."
6 I saw in the middle of the throne and
of the four living creatures, and in the
middle of the elders, a Lamb standing, as
though it had been slain, having seven
horns and seven eyes, which are the seven
Spirits of God, sent out into all the earth.
7 Then he came, and he took it out of the
right hand of him who sat on the throne.
8 Now when he had taken the book, the
four living creatures and the twenty-four
elders fell down before the Lamb, each
one having a harp, and golden bowls full
of incense, which are the prayers of the
saints.
9 They sang a new song, saying,
"You are worthy to take the book
and to open its seals,

† **4:8** Hodges/Farstad MT reads "holy" 9 times instead of 3.
‡ **4:11** TR omits "and God, the Holy One,"

for you were killed,
and bought us for God with your blood
out of every tribe, language, people, and nation,
10 and made us kings and priests to our God;
and we will reign on the earth."

11 I looked, and I heard something like a voice of many angels around the throne, the living creatures, and the elders. The number of them was ten thousands of ten thousands, and thousands of thousands,
12 saying with a loud voice, "Worthy is the Lamb who has been killed to receive the power, wealth, wisdom, strength, honor, glory, and blessing!"

13 I heard every created thing which is in heaven, on the earth, under the earth, on the sea, and everything in them, saying, "To him who sits on the throne and to the Lamb be the blessing, the honor, the glory, and the dominion, forever and ever! Amen!"†
14 The four living creatures said, "Amen!" Then the‡ elders fell down and worshiped.§

6

1 I saw that the Lamb opened one of the seven seals, and I heard one of the four living creatures saying, as with a voice of thunder, "Come and see!"
2 Then a white horse appeared, and he who sat on it had a bow. A crown was given to him, and he came out conquering, and to conquer.

3 When he opened the second seal, I heard the second living creature saying, "Come!"
4 Another came out, a red horse. To him who sat on it was given power to take peace from the earth, and that they should kill one another. There was given to him a great sword.

5 When he opened the third seal, I heard the third living creature saying, "Come and see!" And behold, a black horse, and he who sat on it had a balance in his hand.
6 I heard a voice in the middle of the four living creatures saying, "A choenix† of wheat for a denarius, and three choenix of barley for a denarius! Don't damage the oil and the wine!"

7 When he opened the fourth seal, I heard the fourth living creature saying, "Come and see!"
8 And behold, a pale horse, and the name of he who sat on it was Death. Hades‡ followed with him. Authority over one fourth of the earth, to kill with the sword, with famine, with death, and by the wild animals of the earth was given to him.

9 When he opened the fifth seal, I saw underneath the altar the souls of those who had been killed for the Word of God, and for the testimony of the Lamb which they had.
10 They cried with a loud voice, saying, "How long, Master, the holy and true, until you judge and avenge our blood on those who dwell on the earth?"
11 A long white robe was given to each of them. They were told that they should rest yet for a while, until their fellow servants and their brothers,§ who would also be killed even as they were, should complete their course.

12 I saw when he opened the sixth seal, and there was a great earthquake. The sun became black as sackcloth made of hair, and the whole moon became as blood.
13 The stars of the sky fell to the earth, like a fig tree dropping its unripe figs when it is shaken by a great wind.
14 The sky was removed like a scroll when it is rolled up. Every mountain and island was moved out of its place.
15 The kings of the earth, the princes, the commanding officers, the rich, the strong, and every slave and free person, hid themselves in the caves and in the rocks of the mountains.

† **5:13** TR omits "Amen!" ‡ **5:14** TR adds "twenty-four" § **5:14** TR adds "the one living forever and ever" † **6:6** A choenix is a dry volume measure that is a little more than a liter (a little more than a quart). ‡ **6:8** or, Hell § **6:11** The word for "brothers" here and where context allows may also be correctly translated "brothers and sisters" or "siblings."

16 They told the mountains and the
rocks, “Fall on us, and hide us from the
face of him who sits on the throne, and
from the wrath of the Lamb,
17 for the great day of his wrath has
come, and who is able to stand?”

7

1 After this, I saw four angels standing at
the four corners of the earth, holding the
four winds of the earth, so that no wind
would blow on the earth, or on the sea, or
on any tree.
2 I saw another angel ascend from the
sunrise, having the seal of the living God.
He cried with a loud voice to the four
angels to whom it was given to harm the
earth and the sea,
3 saying, “Don’t harm the earth, the sea,
or the trees, until we have sealed the
bondservants of our God on their
foreheads!”
4 I heard the number of those who were
sealed, one hundred forty-four thousand,
sealed out of every tribe of the children of
Israel:
5 of the tribe of Judah twelve thousand
were sealed,
of the tribe of Reuben twelve thousand,
of the tribe of Gad twelve thousand,
6 of the tribe of Asher twelve thousand,
of the tribe of Naphtali twelve thousand,
of the tribe of Manasseh twelve thousand,
7 of the tribe of Simeon twelve thousand,
of the tribe of Levi twelve thousand,
of the tribe of Issachar twelve thousand,
8 of the tribe of Zebulun twelve thousand,
of the tribe of Joseph twelve thousand,
and
of the tribe of Benjamin twelve thousand
were sealed.
9 After these things I looked, and behold,
a great multitude which no man could
count, out of every nation and of all tribes,
peoples, and languages, standing before
the throne and before the Lamb, dressed
in white robes, with palm branches in
their hands.
10 They cried with a loud voice, saying,
“Salvation be to our God, who sits on the
throne, and to the Lamb!”
11 All the angels were standing around
the throne, the elders, and the four living
creatures; and they fell on their faces
before his throne, and worshiped God,
12 saying, “Amen! Blessing, glory,
wisdom, thanksgiving, honor, power, and
might, be to our God forever and ever!
Amen.”
13 One of the elders answered, saying to
me, “These who are arrayed in the white
robes, who are they, and where did they
come from?”
14 I told him, “My lord, you know.”
He said to me, “These are those who
came out of the great suffering.† They
washed their robes and made them white
in the Lamb’s blood.
15 Therefore they are before the throne
of God, and they serve him day and night
in his temple. He who sits on the throne
will spread his tabernacle over them.
16 They will never be hungry or thirsty
any more. The sun won’t beat on them,
nor any heat;
17 for the Lamb who is in the middle of
the throne shepherds them and leads
them to springs of life-giving waters. And
God will wipe away every tear from their
eyes.”

8

1 When he opened the seventh seal,
there was silence in heaven for about half
an hour.
2 I saw the seven angels who stand
before God, and seven trumpets were
given to them.
3 Another angel came and stood over
the altar, having a golden censer. Much
incense was given to him, that he should
add it to the prayers of all the saints on the
golden altar which was before the throne.
4 The smoke of the incense, with the
prayers of the saints, went up before God
out of the angel’s hand.
5 The angel took the censer, and he filled
it with the fire of the altar, then threw it
on the earth. Thunders, sounds,
lightnings, and an earthquake followed.
6 The seven angels who had the seven
trumpets prepared themselves to sound.

† **7:14** or, oppression

7 The first sounded, and there followed
hail and fire, mixed with blood, and they
were thrown to the earth. One third of the
earth was burned up,† and one third of
the trees were burned up, and all green
grass was burned up.
8 The second angel sounded, and
something like a great burning mountain
was thrown into the sea. One third of the
sea became blood,
9 and one third of the living creatures
which were in the sea died. One third of
the ships were destroyed.
10 The third angel sounded, and a great
star fell from the sky, burning like a torch,
and it fell on one third of the rivers, and
on the springs of water.
11 The name of the star is "Wormwood."
One third of the waters became
wormwood. Many people died from the
waters, because they were made bitter.
12 The fourth angel sounded, and one
third of the sun was struck, and one third
of the moon, and one third of the stars, so
that one third of them would be darkened;
and the day wouldn't shine for one third
of it, and the night in the same way.
13 I saw, and I heard an eagle,‡ flying in
mid heaven, saying with a loud voice,
"Woe! Woe! Woe to those who dwell on
the earth, because of the other blasts of
the trumpets of the three angels, who are
yet to sound!"

9

1 The fifth angel sounded, and I saw a
star from the sky which had fallen to the
earth. The key to the pit of the abyss was
given to him.
2 He opened the pit of the abyss, and
smoke went up out of the pit, like the
smoke from a† burning furnace. The sun
and the air were darkened because of the
smoke from the pit.
3 Then out of the smoke came locusts on
the earth, and power was given to them,
as the scorpions of the earth have power.
4 They were told that they should not
hurt the grass of the earth, neither any
green thing, neither any tree, but only
those people who don't have God's seal on
their foreheads.
5 They were given power, not to kill
them, but to torment them for five
months. Their torment was like the
torment of a scorpion when it strikes a
person.
6 In those days people will seek death,
and will in no way find it. They will desire
to die, and death will flee from them.
7 The shapes of the locusts were like
horses prepared for war. On their heads
were something like golden crowns, and
their faces were like people's faces.
8 They had hair like women's hair, and
their teeth were like those of lions.
9 They had breastplates like
breastplates of iron. The sound of their
wings was like the sound of many chariots
and horses rushing to war.
10 They have tails like those of
scorpions, with stingers. In their tails they
have power to harm men for five months.
11 They have over them as king the
angel of the abyss. His name in Hebrew is
"Abaddon",‡ but in Greek, he has the
name "Apollyon".§
12 The first woe is past. Behold, there
are still two woes coming after this.
13 The sixth angel sounded. I heard a
voice from the horns of the golden altar
which is before God,
14 saying to the sixth angel who had the
trumpet, "Free the four angels who are
bound at the great river Euphrates!"
15 The four angels were freed who had
been prepared for that hour and day and
month and year, so that they might kill
one third of mankind.
16 The number of the armies of the
horsemen was two hundred million.† I
heard the number of them.
17 Thus I saw the horses in the vision
and those who sat on them, having
breastplates of fiery red, hyacinth blue,
and sulfur yellow; and the horses' heads

† **8:7** TR omits "One third of the earth was burned up" ‡ **8:13** TR reads "angel" instead of "eagle" † **9:2** TR adds "great" ‡ **9:11** "Abaddon" is a Hebrew word that means "ruin", "destruction", or "the place of destruction" § **9:11** "Apollyon" means "Destroyer". † **9:16** literally, "ten thousands of ten thousands"

resembled lions' heads. Out of their mouths proceed fire, smoke, and sulfur.
18 By these three plagues, one third of mankind was killed: by the fire, the smoke, and the sulfur, which proceeded out of their mouths.
19 For the power of the horses is in their mouths and in their tails. For their tails are like serpents, and have heads; and with them they harm.
20 The rest of mankind, who were not killed with these plagues, didn't repent of the works of their hands, that they wouldn't worship demons, and the idols of gold, and of silver, and of brass, and of stone, and of wood, which can't see, hear, or walk.
21 They didn't repent of their murders, their sorceries,‡ their sexual immorality, or their thefts.

10

1 I saw a mighty angel coming down out of the sky, clothed with a cloud. A rainbow was on his head. His face was like the sun, and his feet like pillars of fire.
2 He had in his hand a little open book. He set his right foot on the sea, and his left on the land.
3 He cried with a loud voice, as a lion roars. When he cried, the seven thunders uttered their voices.
4 When the seven thunders sounded, I was about to write; but I heard a voice from the sky saying, "Seal up the things which the seven thunders said, and don't write them."
5 The angel whom I saw standing on the sea and on the land lifted up his right hand to the sky
6 and swore by him who lives forever and ever, who created heaven and the things that are in it, the earth and the things that are in it, and the sea and the things that are in it, that there will no longer be delay,
7 but in the days of the voice of the seventh angel, when he is about to sound, then the mystery of God is finished, as he declared to his servants the prophets.
8 The voice which I heard from heaven, again speaking with me, said, "Go, take the book which is open in the hand of the angel who stands on the sea and on the land."
9 I went to the angel, telling him to give me the little book.
He said to me, "Take it and eat it. It will make your stomach bitter, but in your mouth it will be as sweet as honey."
10 I took the little book out of the angel's hand, and ate it. It was as sweet as honey in my mouth. When I had eaten it, my stomach was made bitter.
11 They† told me, "You must prophesy again over many peoples, nations, languages, and kings."

11

1 A reed like a rod was given to me. Someone said, "Rise and measure God's temple, and the altar, and those who worship in it.
2 Leave out the court which is outside of the temple, and don't measure it, for it has been given to the nations. They will tread the holy city under foot for forty-two months.
3 I will give power to my two witnesses, and they will prophesy one thousand two hundred sixty days, clothed in sackcloth."
4 These are the two olive trees and the two lamp stands, standing before the Lord of the earth.
5 If anyone desires to harm them, fire proceeds out of their mouth and devours their enemies. If anyone desires to harm them, he must be killed in this way.
6 These have the power to shut up the sky, that it may not rain during the days of their prophecy. They have power over the waters, to turn them into blood, and to strike the earth with every plague, as often as they desire.
7 When they have finished their testimony, the beast that comes up out of the abyss will make war with them, and overcome them, and kill them.
8 Their dead bodies will be in the street of the great city, which spiritually is called

‡ **9:21** The word for "sorceries" (pharmakeia) also implies the use of potions, poisons, and drugs † **10:11** TR reads "He" instead of "They"

Sodom and Egypt, where also their Lord was crucified.
9 From among the peoples, tribes, languages, and nations, people will look at their dead bodies for three and a half days, and will not allow their dead bodies to be laid in a tomb.
10 Those who dwell on the earth will rejoice over them, and they will be glad. They will give gifts to one another, because these two prophets tormented those who dwell on the earth.
11 After the three and a half days, the breath of life from God entered into them, and they stood on their feet. Great fear fell on those who saw them.
12 I heard a loud voice from heaven saying to them, "Come up here!" They went up into heaven in a cloud, and their enemies saw them.
13 In that day there was a great earthquake, and a tenth of the city fell. Seven thousand people were killed in the earthquake, and the rest were terrified and gave glory to the God of heaven.
14 The second woe is past. Behold, the third woe comes quickly.
15 The seventh angel sounded, and great voices in heaven followed, saying, "The kingdom of the world has become the Kingdom of our Lord and of his Christ. He will reign forever and ever!"
16 The twenty-four elders, who sit on their thrones before God's throne, fell on their faces and worshiped God,
17 saying: "We give you thanks, Lord God, the Almighty, the one who is and who was,† because you have taken your great power and reigned.
18 The nations were angry, and your wrath came, as did the time for the dead to be judged, and to give your bondservants the prophets, their reward, as well as to the saints and those who fear your name, to the small and the great, and to destroy those who destroy the earth."
19 God's temple that is in heaven was opened, and the ark of the Lord's covenant was seen in his temple. Lightnings, sounds, thunders, an earthquake, and great hail followed.

† **11:17** TR adds "and who is coming"

12

1 A great sign was seen in heaven: a woman clothed with the sun, and the moon under her feet, and on her head a crown of twelve stars.
2 She was with child. She cried out in pain, laboring to give birth.
3 Another sign was seen in heaven. Behold, a great red dragon, having seven heads and ten horns, and on his heads seven crowns.
4 His tail drew one third of the stars of the sky, and threw them to the earth. The dragon stood before the woman who was about to give birth, so that when she gave birth he might devour her child.
5 She gave birth to a son, a male child, who is to rule all the nations with a rod of iron. Her child was caught up to God and to his throne.
6 The woman fled into the wilderness, where she has a place prepared by God, that there they may nourish her one thousand two hundred sixty days.
7 There was war in the sky. Michael and his angels made war on the dragon. The dragon and his angels made war.
8 They didn't prevail. No place was found for them any more in heaven.
9 The great dragon was thrown down, the old serpent, he who is called the devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world. He was thrown down to the earth, and his angels were thrown down with him.
10 I heard a loud voice in heaven, saying, "Now the salvation, the power, and the Kingdom of our God, and the authority of his Christ has come; for the accuser of our brothers has been thrown down, who accuses them before our God day and night.
11 They overcame him because of the Lamb's blood, and because of the word of their testimony. They didn't love their life, even to death.
12 Therefore rejoice, heavens, and you who dwell in them. Woe to the earth and to the sea, because the devil has gone down to you, having great wrath, knowing that he has but a short time."

13 When the dragon saw that he was
thrown down to the earth, he persecuted
the woman who gave birth to the male
child.
14 Two wings of the great eagle were
given to the woman, that she might fly
into the wilderness to her place, so that
she might be nourished for a time, times,
and half a time, from the face of the
serpent.
15 The serpent spewed water out of his
mouth after the woman like a river, that
he might cause her to be carried away by
the stream.
16 The earth helped the woman, and the
earth opened its mouth and swallowed up
the river which the dragon spewed out of
his mouth.
17 The dragon grew angry with the
woman, and went away to make war with
the rest of her offspring,† who keep God's
commandments and hold Jesus'
testimony.

13

1 Then I stood† on the sand of the sea. I
saw a beast coming up out of the sea,
having ten horns and seven heads. On his
horns were ten crowns, and on his heads,
blasphemous names.
2 The beast which I saw was like a
leopard, and his feet were like those of a
bear, and his mouth like the mouth of a
lion. The dragon gave him his power, his
throne, and great authority.
3 One of his heads looked like it had
been wounded fatally. His fatal wound
was healed, and the whole earth
marveled at the beast.
4 They worshiped the dragon because
he gave his authority to the beast; and
they worshiped the beast, saying, "Who is
like the beast? Who is able to make war
with him?"
5 A mouth speaking great things and
blasphemy was given to him. Authority to
make war for forty-two months was given
to him.
6 He opened his mouth for blasphemy
against God, to blaspheme his name, his
dwelling, and those who dwell in heaven.
7 It was given to him to make war with
the saints and to overcome them.
Authority over every tribe, people,
language, and nation was given to him.
8 All who dwell on the earth will
worship him, everyone whose name has
not been written from the foundation of
the world in the book of life of the Lamb
who has been killed.
9 If anyone has an ear, let him hear.
10 If anyone is to go into captivity, he
will go into captivity. If anyone is to be
killed with the sword, he must be killed.‡
Here is the endurance and the faith of the
saints.
11 I saw another beast coming up out of
the earth. He had two horns like a lamb
and it spoke like a dragon.
12 He exercises all the authority of the
first beast in his presence. He makes the
earth and those who dwell in it to worship
the first beast, whose fatal wound was
healed.
13 He performs great signs, even making
fire come down out of the sky to the earth
in the sight of people.
14 He deceives my own§ people who
dwell on the earth because of the signs he
was granted to do in front of the beast,
saying to those who dwell on the earth
that they should make an image to the
beast who had the sword wound and
lived.
15 It was given to him to give breath to
the image of the beast, that the image of
the beast should both speak, and cause as
many as wouldn't worship the image of
the beast to be killed.
16 He causes all, the small and the great,
the rich and the poor, and the free and the
slave, to be given marks on their right
hands or on their foreheads;
17 and that no one would be able to buy
or to sell unless he has that mark, which is
the name of the beast or the number of his
name.

† **12:17** or, seed † **13:1** NU reads *he stood* ‡ **13:10** TR reads "If anyone leads into captivity, into captivity he goes. If anyone will kill with the sword, he must be killed with a sword." instead of "If anyone is to go into captivity, he will go into captivity. If anyone is to be killed with the sword, he must be killed." § **13:14** NU omits "my own"

18 Here is wisdom. He who has
understanding, let him calculate the
number of the beast, for it is the number
of a man. His number is six hundred
sixty-six.

14

1 I saw, and behold, the Lamb standing
on Mount Zion, and with him a number,
one hundred forty-four thousand, having
his name and the name of his Father
written on their foreheads.
2 I heard a sound from heaven like the
sound of many waters and like the sound
of a great thunder. The sound which I
heard was like that of harpists playing on
their harps.
3 They sing a new song before the
throne and before the four living
creatures and the elders. No one could
learn the song except the one hundred
forty-four thousand, those who had been
redeemed out of the earth.
4 These are those who were not defiled
with women, for they are virgins. These
are those who follow the Lamb wherever
he goes. These were redeemed by Jesus
from among men, the first fruits to God
and to the Lamb.
5 In their mouth was found no lie, for
they are blameless.†

6 I saw an angel flying in mid heaven,
having an eternal Good News to proclaim
to those who dwell on the earth—to every
nation, tribe, language, and people.
7 He said with a loud voice, "Fear the
Lord, and give him glory, for the hour of
his judgment has come. Worship him who
made the heaven, the earth, the sea, and
the springs of waters!"

8 Another, a second angel, followed,
saying, "Babylon the great has fallen,
which has made all the nations to drink of
the wine of the wrath of her sexual
immorality."

9 Another angel, a third, followed them,
saying with a great voice, "If anyone
worships the beast and his image, and
receives a mark on his forehead or on his
hand,
10 he also will drink of the wine of the
wrath of God, which is prepared unmixed
in the cup of his anger. He will be
tormented with fire and sulfur in the
presence of the holy angels and in the
presence of the Lamb.
11 The smoke of their torment goes up
forever and ever. They have no rest day
and night, those who worship the beast
and his image, and whoever receives the
mark of his name.
12 Here is the perseverance of the saints,
those who keep the commandments of
God and the faith of Jesus."
13 I heard a voice from heaven saying,
"Write, 'Blessed are the dead who die in
the Lord from now on.' "
"Yes," says the Spirit, "that they may rest
from their labors, for their works follow
with them."
14 I looked, and saw a white cloud, and
on the cloud one sitting like a son of man,*
having on his head a golden crown, and in
his hand a sharp sickle.
15 Another angel came out of the temple,
crying with a loud voice to him who sat on
the cloud, "Send your sickle and reap, for
the hour to reap has come; for the harvest
of the earth is ripe!"
16 He who sat on the cloud thrust his
sickle on the earth, and the earth was
reaped.
17 Another angel came out of the temple
which is in heaven. He also had a sharp
sickle.
18 Another angel came out from the
altar, he who has power over fire, and he
called with a great voice to him who had
the sharp sickle, saying, "Send your sharp
sickle and gather the clusters of the vine
of the earth, for the earth's grapes are
fully ripe!"
19 The angel thrust his sickle into the
earth, and gathered the vintage of the
earth and threw it into the great wine
press of the wrath of God.
20 The wine press was trodden outside
of the city, and blood came out of the wine
press, up to the bridles of the horses, as
far as one thousand six hundred stadia.‡

† **14:5** TR adds "before the throne of God" * **14:14** Daniel 7:13 ‡ **14:20** 1600 stadia = 296 kilometers or 184 miles

15

1 I saw another great and marvelous
sign in the sky: seven angels having the
seven last plagues, for in them God's
wrath is finished.
2 I saw something like a sea of glass
mixed with fire, and those who overcame
the beast, his image,† and the number of
his name, standing on the sea of glass,
having harps of God.
3 They sang the song of Moses, the
servant of God, and the song of the Lamb,
saying,
"Great and marvelous are your works,
Lord God, the Almighty!
Righteous and true are your ways,
you King of the nations.
4 Who wouldn't fear you, Lord,
and glorify your name?
For you only are holy.
For all the nations will come and
worship before you.
For your righteous acts have been
revealed."
5 After these things I looked, and the
temple of the tabernacle of the testimony
in heaven was opened.
6 The seven angels who had the seven
plagues came out, clothed with pure,
bright linen, and wearing golden sashes
around their chests.
7 One of the four living creatures gave to
the seven angels seven golden bowls full
of the wrath of God, who lives forever and
ever.
8 The temple was filled with smoke from
the glory of God and from his power. No
one was able to enter into the temple until
the seven plagues of the seven angels
would be finished.

16

1 I heard a loud voice out of the temple,
saying to the seven angels, "Go and pour
out the seven bowls of the wrath of God
on the earth!"
2 The first went, and poured out his
bowl into the earth, and it became a
harmful and painful sore on the people
who had the mark of the beast, and who
worshiped his image.
3 The second angel poured out his bowl
into the sea, and it became blood as of a
dead man. Every living thing in the sea
died.
4 The third poured out his bowl into the
rivers and springs of water, and they
became blood.
5 I heard the angel of the waters saying,
"You are righteous, who are and who
were, O Holy One, because you have
judged these things.
6 For they poured out the blood of saints
and prophets, and you have given them
blood to drink. They deserve this."
7 I heard the altar saying, "Yes, Lord
God, the Almighty, true and righteous are
your judgments."
8 The fourth poured out his bowl on the
sun, and it was given to him to scorch men
with fire.
9 People were scorched with great heat,
and people blasphemed the name of God
who has the power over these plagues.
They didn't repent and give him glory.
10 The fifth poured out his bowl on the
throne of the beast, and his kingdom was
darkened. They gnawed their tongues
because of the pain,
11 and they blasphemed the God of
heaven because of their pains and their
sores. They still didn't repent of their
works.
12 The sixth poured out his bowl on the
great river, the Euphrates. Its water was
dried up, that the way might be prepared
for the kings that come from the sunrise.†
13 I saw coming out of the mouth of the
dragon, and out of the mouth of the beast,
and out of the mouth of the false prophet,
three unclean spirits, something like
frogs;
14 for they are spirits of demons,
performing signs, which go out to the
kings of the whole inhabited earth, to
gather them together for the war of that
great day of God the Almighty.
15 "Behold, I come like a thief. Blessed is
he who watches, and keeps his clothes, so
that he doesn't walk naked, and they see
his shame."

† **15:2** TR adds "his mark," † **16:12** or, east

16 He gathered them together into the
place which is called in Hebrew,
“Harmagedon”.
17 The seventh poured out his bowl into
the air. A loud voice came out of the
temple of heaven, from the throne,
saying, “It is done!”
18 There were lightnings, sounds, and
thunders; and there was a great
earthquake such as has not happened
since there were men on the earth—so
great an earthquake and so mighty.
19 The great city was divided into three
parts, and the cities of the nations fell.
Babylon the great was remembered in the
sight of God, to give to her the cup of the
wine of the fierceness of his wrath.
20 Every island fled away, and the
mountains were not found.
21 Great hailstones, about the weight of
a talent,‡ came down out of the sky on
people. People blasphemed God because
of the plague of the hail, for this plague
was exceedingly severe.

17

1 One of the seven angels who had the
seven bowls came and spoke with me,
saying, “Come here. I will show you the
judgment of the great prostitute who sits
on many waters,
2 with whom the kings of the earth
committed sexual immorality. Those who
dwell in the earth were made drunken
with the wine of her sexual immorality.”
3 He carried me away in the Spirit into a
wilderness. I saw a woman sitting on a
scarlet-colored beast, full of blasphemous
names, having seven heads and ten horns.
4 The woman was dressed in purple and
scarlet, and decked with gold and
precious stones and pearls, having in her
hand a golden cup full of abominations
and the impurities of the sexual
immorality of the earth.
5 And on her forehead a name was
written, “MYSTERY, BABYLON THE
GREAT, THE MOTHER OF THE
PROSTITUTES AND OF THE
ABOMINATIONS OF THE EARTH.”
6 I saw the woman drunken with the
blood of the saints and with the blood of
the martyrs of Jesus. When I saw her, I
wondered with great amazement.
7 The angel said to me, “Why do you
wonder? I will tell you the mystery of the
woman and of the beast that carries her,
which has the seven heads and the ten
horns.
8 The beast that you saw was, and is not;
and is about to come up out of the abyss
and to go into destruction. Those who
dwell on the earth and whose names have
not been written in the book of life from
the foundation of the world will marvel
when they see that the beast was, and is
not, and shall be present.†
9 Here is the mind that has wisdom. The
seven heads are seven mountains on
which the woman sits.
10 They are seven kings. Five have
fallen, the one is, and the other has not yet
come. When he comes, he must continue
a little while.
11 The beast that was, and is not, is
himself also an eighth, and is of the seven;
and he goes to destruction.
12 The ten horns that you saw are ten
kings who have received no kingdom as
yet, but they receive authority as kings
with the beast for one hour.
13 These have one mind, and they give
their power and authority to the beast.
14 These will war against the Lamb, and
the Lamb will overcome them, for he is
Lord of lords and King of kings; and those
who are with him are called, chosen, and
faithful.”
15 He said to me, “The waters which you
saw, where the prostitute sits, are peoples,
multitudes, nations, and languages.
16 The ten horns which you saw, they
and the beast will hate the prostitute, will
make her desolate, will strip her naked,
will eat her flesh, and will burn her
utterly with fire.
17 For God has put in their hearts to do
what he has in mind, to be of one mind,
and to give their kingdom to the beast,
until the words of God should be
accomplished.

‡ **16:21** A talent is about 30 kilograms or 66 pounds.

† **17:8** TR reads “yet is” instead of “shall be present”

18 The woman whom you saw is the
great city which reigns over the kings of
the earth."

18

1 After these things, I saw another angel
coming down out of the sky, having great
authority. The earth was illuminated with
his glory.
2 He cried with a mighty voice, saying,
"Fallen, fallen is Babylon the great, and
she has become a habitation of demons, a
prison of every unclean spirit, and a
prison of every unclean and hated bird!
3 For all the nations have drunk of the
wine of the wrath of her sexual
immorality, the kings of the earth
committed sexual immorality with her,
and the merchants of the earth grew rich
from the abundance of her luxury."

4 I heard another voice from heaven,
saying, "Come out of her, my people, that
you have no participation in her sins, and
that you don't receive of her plagues,
5 for her sins have reached to the sky,
and God has remembered her iniquities.
6 Return to her just as she returned, and
repay her double as she did, and
according to her works. In the cup which
she mixed, mix to her double.
7 However much she glorified herself
and grew wanton, so much give her of
torment and mourning. For she says in
her heart, 'I sit a queen, and am no widow,
and will in no way see mourning.'
8 Therefore in one day her plagues will
come: death, mourning, and famine; and
she will be utterly burned with fire, for
the Lord God who has judged her is
strong.

9 The kings of the earth who committed
sexual immorality and lived wantonly
with her will weep and wail over her,
when they look at the smoke of her
burning,
10 standing far away for the fear of her
torment, saying, 'Woe, woe, the great city,
Babylon, the strong city! For your
judgment has come in one hour.'

11 The merchants of the earth weep and
mourn over her, for no one buys their
merchandise any more:
12 merchandise of gold, silver, precious
stones, pearls, fine linen, purple, silk,
scarlet, all expensive wood, every vessel
of ivory, every vessel made of most
precious wood, and of brass, and iron,
and marble;
13 and cinnamon, incense, perfume,
frankincense, wine, olive oil, fine flour,
wheat, cattle, sheep, horses, chariots, and
people's bodies and souls.
14 The fruits which your soul lusted
after have been lost to you. All things that
were dainty and sumptuous have
perished from you, and you will find them
no more at all.
15 The merchants of these things, who
were made rich by her, will stand far
away for the fear of her torment, weeping
and mourning,
16 saying, 'Woe, woe, the great city, she
who was dressed in fine linen, purple, and
scarlet, and decked with gold and
precious stones and pearls!
17 For in an hour such great riches are
made desolate.' Every ship master, and
everyone who sails anywhere, and
mariners, and as many as gain their living
by sea, stood far away,
18 and cried out as they looked at the
smoke of her burning, saying, 'What is
like the great city?'
19 They cast dust on their heads, and
cried, weeping and mourning, saying,
'Woe, woe, the great city, in which all who
had their ships in the sea were made rich
by reason of her great wealth!' For she is
made desolate in one hour.
20 "Rejoice over her, O heaven, you
saints, apostles, and prophets, for God has
judged your judgment on her."
21 A mighty angel took up a stone like a
great millstone and cast it into the sea,
saying, "Thus with violence will Babylon,
the great city, be thrown down, and will
be found no more at all.
22 The voice of harpists, minstrels, flute
players, and trumpeters will be heard no
more at all in you. No craftsman of

whatever craft will be found any more at all in you. The sound of a mill will be heard no more at all in you.
23 The light of a lamp will shine no more at all in you. The voice of the bridegroom and of the bride will be heard no more at all in you, for your merchants were the princes of the earth; for with your sorcery all the nations were deceived.
24 In her was found the blood of prophets and of saints, and of all who have been slain on the earth."

19

1 After these things I heard something like a loud voice of a great multitude in heaven, saying, "Hallelujah! Salvation, power, and glory belong to our God;
2 for his judgments are true and righteous. For he has judged the great prostitute who corrupted the earth with her sexual immorality, and he has avenged the blood of his servants at her hand."
3 A second said, "Hallelujah! Her smoke goes up forever and ever."
4 The twenty-four elders and the four living creatures fell down and worshiped God who sits on the throne, saying, "Amen! Hallelujah!"
5 A voice came from the throne, saying, "Give praise to our God, all you his servants, you who fear him, the small and the great!"
6 I heard something like the voice of a great multitude, and like the voice of many waters, and like the voice of mighty thunders, saying, "Hallelujah! For the Lord our God, the Almighty, reigns!
7 Let's rejoice and be exceedingly glad, and let's give the glory to him. For the wedding of the Lamb has come, and his wife has made herself ready."
8 It was given to her that she would array herself in bright, pure, fine linen, for the fine linen is the righteous acts of the saints.
9 He said to me, "Write, 'Blessed are those who are invited to the wedding supper of the Lamb.' " He said to me, "These are true words of God."
10 I fell down before his feet to worship him. He said to me, "Look! Don't do it! I am a fellow bondservant with you and with your brothers who hold the testimony of Jesus. Worship God, for the testimony of Jesus is the Spirit of Prophecy."
11 I saw heaven opened, and behold, a white horse, and he who sat on it is called Faithful and True. In righteousness he judges and makes war.
12 His eyes are a flame of fire, and on his head are many crowns. He has names written and a name written which no one knows but he himself.
13 He is clothed in a garment sprinkled with blood. His name is called "The Word of God."
14 The armies which are in heaven, clothed in white, pure, fine linen, followed him on white horses.
15 Out of his mouth proceeds a sharp, double-edged sword that with it he should strike the nations. He will rule them with an iron rod.* He treads the wine press of the fierceness of the wrath of God, the Almighty.
16 He has on his garment and on his thigh a name written, "KING OF KINGS AND LORD OF LORDS."
17 I saw an angel standing in the sun. He cried with a loud voice, saying to all the birds that fly in the sky, "Come! Be gathered together to the great supper of God,†
18 that you may eat the flesh of kings, the flesh of captains, the flesh of mighty men, and the flesh of horses and of those who sit on them, and the flesh of all men, both free and slave, small and great."
19 I saw the beast, the kings of the earth, and their armies, gathered together to make war against him who sat on the horse and against his army.
20 The beast was taken, and with him the false prophet who worked the signs in his sight, with which he deceived those who had received the mark of the beast and those who worshiped his image.

* **19:15** Psalms 2:9 † **19:17** TR reads "supper of the great God" instead of "great supper of God"

These two were thrown alive into the lake of fire that burns with sulfur.
21 The rest were killed with the sword of him who sat on the horse, the sword which came out of his mouth. So all the birds were filled with their flesh.

20

1 I saw an angel coming down out of heaven, having the key of the abyss and a great chain in his hand.
2 He seized the dragon, the old serpent, who is the devil and Satan, who deceives the whole inhabited earth,† and bound him for a thousand years,
3 and cast him into the abyss, and shut it and sealed it over him, that he should deceive the nations no more until the thousand years were finished. After this, he must be freed for a short time.
4 I saw thrones, and they sat on them, and judgment was given to them. I saw the souls of those who had been beheaded for the testimony of Jesus and for the word of God, and such as didn't worship the beast nor his image, and didn't receive the mark on their forehead and on their hand. They lived and reigned with Christ for a thousand years.
5 The rest of the dead didn't live until the thousand years were finished. This is the first resurrection.
6 Blessed and holy is he who has part in the first resurrection. Over these, the second death has no power, but they will be priests of God and of Christ, and will reign with him one thousand years.
7 And after the thousand years, Satan will be released from his prison
8 and he will come out to deceive the nations which are in the four corners of the earth, Gog and Magog, to gather them together to the war, whose number is as the sand of the sea.
9 They went up over the width of the earth and surrounded the camp of the saints and the beloved city. Fire came down out of heaven from God and devoured them.
10 The devil who deceived them was thrown into the lake of fire and sulfur, where the beast and the false prophet are also. They will be tormented day and night forever and ever.
11 I saw a great white throne and him who sat on it, from whose face the earth and the sky fled away. There was found no place for them.
12 I saw the dead, the great and the small, standing before the throne, and they opened books. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged out of the things which were written in the books, according to their works.
13 The sea gave up the dead who were in it. Death and Hades‡ gave up the dead who were in them. They were judged, each one according to his works.
14 Death and Hades§ were thrown into the lake of fire. This is the second death, the lake of fire.
15 If anyone was not found written in the book of life, he was cast into the lake of fire.

21

1 I saw a new heaven and a new earth, for the first heaven and the first earth have passed away, and the sea is no more.
2 I saw the holy city, New Jerusalem, coming down out of heaven from God, prepared like a bride adorned for her husband.
3 I heard a loud voice out of heaven saying, "Behold, God's dwelling is with people; and he will dwell with them, and they will be his people, and God himself will be with them as their God.
4 He will wipe away every tear from their eyes. Death will be no more; neither will there be mourning, nor crying, nor pain any more. The first things have passed away."

5 He who sits on the throne said, "Behold, I am making all things new." He said, "Write, for these words of God are faithful and true."
6 He said to me, "I am the Alpha and the Omega, the Beginning and the End. I will give freely to him who is thirsty from the spring of the water of life.

† **20:2** TR and NU omit "who deceives the whole inhabited earth". ‡ **20:13** or, Hell § **20:14** or, Hell

7 He who overcomes, I will give him
these things. I will be his God, and he will
be my son.
8 But for the cowardly, unbelieving,
sinners,† abominable, murderers,
sexually immoral, sorcerers,‡ idolaters,
and all liars, their part is in the lake that
burns with fire and sulfur, which is the
second death."
9 One of the seven angels who had the
seven bowls which were loaded with the
seven last plagues came, and he spoke
with me, saying, "Come here. I will show
you the bride, the Lamb's wife."
10 He carried me away in the Spirit to a
great and high mountain, and showed me
the holy city, Jerusalem, coming down out
of heaven from God,
11 having the glory of God. Her light was
like a most precious stone, like a jasper
stone, clear as crystal;
12 having a great and high wall with
twelve gates, and at the gates twelve
angels, and names written on them,
which are the names of the twelve tribes
of the children of Israel.
13 On the east were three gates, and on
the north three gates, and on the south
three gates, and on the west three gates.
14 The wall of the city had twelve
foundations, and on them twelve names
of the twelve Apostles of the Lamb.
15 He who spoke with me had for a
measure a golden reed to measure the
city, its gates, and its walls.
16 The city is square. Its length is as great
as its width. He measured the city with
the reed: twelve thousand twelve stadia.§
Its length, width, and height are equal.
17 Its wall is one hundred forty-four
cubits,† by the measure of a man, that is,
of an angel.
18 The construction of its wall was
jasper. The city was pure gold, like pure
glass.
19 The foundations of the city's wall
were adorned with all kinds of precious
stones. The first foundation was jasper,
the second sapphire,‡ the third
chalcedony, the fourth emerald,
20 the fifth sardonyx, the sixth sardius,
the seventh chrysolite, the eighth beryl,
the ninth topaz, the tenth chrysoprase, the
eleventh jacinth, and the twelfth
amethyst.
21 The twelve gates were twelve pearls.
Each one of the gates was made of one
pearl. The street of the city was pure gold,
like transparent glass.
22 I saw no temple in it, for the Lord God
the Almighty and the Lamb are its temple.
23 The city has no need for the sun or
moon to shine, for the very glory of God
illuminated it and its lamp is the Lamb.
24 The nations will walk in its light. The
kings of the earth bring the glory and
honor of the nations into it.
25 Its gates will in no way be shut by day
(for there will be no night there),
26 and they shall bring the glory and the
honor of the nations into it so that they
may enter.
27 There will in no way enter into it
anything profane, or one who causes an
abomination or a lie, but only those who
are written in the Lamb's book of life.

22

1 He showed me a† river of water of life,
clear as crystal, proceeding out of the
throne of God and of the Lamb,
2 in the middle of its street. On this side
of the river and on that was the tree of life,
bearing twelve kinds of fruits, yielding its
fruit every month. The leaves of the tree
were for the healing of the nations.
3 There will be no curse any more. The
throne of God and of the Lamb will be in
it, and his servants will serve him.
4 They will see his face, and his name
will be on their foreheads.
5 There will be no night, and they need
no lamp light or sun light; for the Lord
God will illuminate them. They will reign
forever and ever.

† **21:8** TR and NU omit "sinners" ‡ **21:8** The word for "sorcerers" here also includes users of potions and drugs.
§ **21:16** 12,012 stadia = 2,221 kilometers or 1,380 miles. TR reads 12,000 stadia instead of 12,012 stadia. † **21:17** 144 cubits is about 65.8 meters or 216 feet ‡ **21:19** or, lapis lazuli † **22:1** TR adds "pure"

6 He said to me, “These words are
faithful and true. The Lord God of the
spirits of the prophets sent his angel to
show to his bondservants the things
which must happen soon.”
7 “Behold, I am coming soon! Blessed is
he who keeps the words of the prophecy
of this book.”
8 Now I, John, am the one who heard
and saw these things. When I heard and
saw, I fell down to worship before the feet
of the angel who had shown me these
things.
9 He said to me, “You must not do that! I
am a fellow bondservant with you and
with your brothers, the prophets, and
with those who keep the words of this
book. Worship God.”
10 He said to me, “Don’t seal up the
words of the prophecy of this book, for the
time is at hand.
11 He who acts unjustly, let him act
unjustly still. He who is filthy, let him be
filthy still. He who is righteous, let him do
righteousness still. He who is holy, let him
be holy still.”
12 “Behold, I am coming soon! My
reward is with me, to repay to each man
according to his work.
13 I am the Alpha and the Omega, the
First and the Last, the Beginning and the
End.
14 Blessed are those who do his
commandments,‡ that they may have the
right to the tree of life, and may enter in
by the gates into the city.
15 Outside are the dogs, the sorcerers,
the sexually immoral, the murderers, the
idolaters, and everyone who loves and
practices falsehood.
16 I, Jesus, have sent my angel to testify
these things to you for the assemblies. I
am the root and the offspring of David, the
Bright and Morning Star.”
17 The Spirit and the bride say, “Come!”
He who hears, let him say, “Come!” He
who is thirsty, let him come. He who
desires, let him take the water of life
freely.
18 I testify to everyone who hears the
words of the prophecy of this book: if
anyone adds to them, God will add to him
the plagues which are written in this
book.
19 If anyone takes away from the words
of the book of this prophecy, God will take
away his part from the tree§ of life, and
out of the holy city, which are written in
this book.
20 He who testifies these things says,
“Yes, I am coming soon.”
Amen! Yes, come, Lord Jesus!
21 The grace of the Lord Jesus Christ be
with all the saints. Amen.

‡ **22:14** NU reads “wash their robes” instead of “do his commandments”. § **22:19** TR reads “Book” instead of “tree”

World English Bible Glossary

The following words used in the World English Bible (WEB) are not very common, either because they refer to ancient weights, measures, or money, or because they are in some way unique to the Bible.

Abaddon Abaddon is Hebrew for destruction.

Abba Abba is a Chaldee word for father, used in a respectful, affectionate, and familiar way, like papa, dad, or daddy. Often used in prayer to refer to our Father in Heaven.

adultery Adultery is having sexual intercourse with someone besides your own husband or wife. In the Bible, the only legitimate sexual intercourse is between a man and a woman who are married to each other.

alpha Alpha is the first letter of the Greek alphabet. It is sometimes used to mean the beginning or the first.

amen Amen means "So be it" or "I believe it is certainly so."

angel "Angel" literally means "messenger" or "envoy," and is usually used to refer to spiritual beings who normally are invisible to us, but can also appear as exceedingly strong creatures or as humans.

Apollyon Apollyon is Greek for destroyer.

apostle "Apostle" means a delegate, messenger, or one sent forth with orders. This term is applied in the New Testament in both a general sense connected with a ministry of establishing and strengthening church fellowships, as well as in a specific sense to "The 12 Apostles of the Lamb" (Revelation 21:14). The former category applies to a specific ministry that continues in the Church (Ephesians 4:11-13) and which includes many more than 12 people, while the latter refers to the apostles named in Matthew 10:2-4, except with Judas Iscariot replaced by Matthias (Acts 1:26).

Armageddon See Har-magedon.

assarion An assarion is a small Roman copper coin worth one tenth of a drachma, or about an hour's wages for an agricultural laborer.

aureus An aureus is a Roman gold coin, worth 25 silver denarii. An aureus weighed from 115 to 126.3 grains (7.45 to 8.18 grams).

baptize Baptize means to immerse in, or wash with something, usually water. Baptism in the Holy Spirit, fire, the Body of Christ, and suffering are also mentioned in the New Testament, along with baptism in water. Baptism is not just to cleanse the body, but as an outward sign of an inward spiritual cleansing and commitment. Baptism is a sign of repentance, as practiced by John the Baptizer, and of faith in Jesus Christ, as practiced by Jesus' disciples.

bath A bath is a liquid measure of about 22 liters, 5.8 U. S. gallons, or 4.8 imperial gallons.

batos A batos is a liquid measure of about 39.5 liters, 10.4 U. S. gallons, or 8.7 imperial gallons.

Beelzebul literally, lord of the flies. A name used for the devil.

Beersheba Beersheba is Hebrew for "well of the oath" or "well of the seven." A city in Israel.

behold Look! See! Wow! Notice this! Lo!

cherub A cherub is a kind of angel with wings and hands that is associated with the throne room of God and guardian duty. See Ezekiel 10.

cherubim Cherubim means more than one cherub or a mighty cherub.

choenix A choenix is a dry volume measure that is a little more than a liter (which is a little more than a quart). A choenix was the daily ration of grain for a soldier in some armies.

concubine a woman who is united to a man for the purpose of providing him with sexual pleasure and children, but not being honored as a full partner in marriage; a second-class

wife. In Old Testament times (and in some places now), it was the custom of middle-eastern kings, chiefs, and wealthy men to marry multiple wives and concubines, but God commanded the Kings of Israel not to do so (Deuteronomy 17:17) and Jesus encouraged people to either remain single or marry as God originally intended: one man married to one woman (Matthew 19:3-12; 1 Corinthians 7:1-13).

cor A cor is a dry measure of about 391 liters, 103 U. S. gallons, or 86 imperial gallons.

corban Corban is a Hebrew word for an offering devoted to God.

crucify Crucify means to execute someone by nailing them to a cross with metal spikes. Their hands are stretched out on the crossbeam with spikes driven through their wrists or hands. Their feet or ankles are attached to a cross with a metal spike. The weight of the victim's body tends to force the air out of his lungs. To rise up to breathe, the victim has to put weight on the wounds, and use a lot of strength. The victim is nailed to the cross while the cross is on the ground, then the cross is raised up and dropped into a hole, thus jarring the wounds. Before crucifixion, the victim was usually whipped with a Roman cat of nine tails, which had bits of glass and metal tied to its ends. This caused chunks of flesh to be removed and open wounds to be placed against the raw wood of the cross. The victim was made to carry the heavy crossbeam of his cross from the place of judgment to the place of crucifixion, but often was physically unable after the scourging, so another person would be pressed into involuntary service to carry the cross for him. Roman crucifixion was generally done totally naked to maximize both shame and discomfort. Eventually, the pain, weakness, dehydration, and exhaustion of the muscles needed to breathe make breathing impossible, and the victim suffocates.

cubit A cubit is a unit of linear measure, from the elbow to the tip of the longest finger of a man. This unit is commonly converted to 0.46 meters or 18 inches, although that varies with height of the man doing the measurement. There is also a "long" cubit that is longer than a regular cubit by a handbreadth. (Ezekiel 43:13)

cummin Cummin is an aromatic seed from Cuminum cyminum, resembling caraway in flavor and appearance. It is used as a spice.

darnel Darnel is a weed grass (probably bearded darnel or Lolium temulentum) that looks very much like wheat until it is mature, when the seeds reveal a great difference. Darnel seeds aren't good for much except as chicken feed or to burn to prevent the spread of this weed.

denarii denarii: plural form of denarius, a silver Roman coin worth about a day's wages for a laborer.

denarius A denarius is a silver Roman coin worth about a day's wages for an agricultural laborer. A denarius was worth 1/25th of a Roman aureus.

devil The word "devil" comes from the Greek "diabolos," which means "one prone to slander; a liar." "Devil" is used to refer to a fallen angel, also called "Satan," who works to steal, kill, destroy, and do evil. The devil's doom is certain, and it is only a matter of time before he is thrown into the Lake of Fire, never to escape.

didrachma A didrachma is a Greek silver coin worth 2 drachmas, about as much as 2 Roman denarii, or about 2 days wages. It was commonly used to pay the half-shekel temple tax.

disciple a student who follows a teacher to learn both by precept and example.

distaff part of a spinning wheel used for twisting threads.

drachma A drachma is a Greek silver coin worth about one Roman denarius, or about a day's wages for

an agricultural laborer.

El-Elohe-Israel El-Elohe-Israel means "God, the God of Israel" or "The God of Israel is mighty."

ephah An ephah is a measure of volume of about 22 liters, 5.8 U. S. gallons, 4.8 imperial gallons, or a bit more than half a bushel.

Gehenna Gehenna is one word used for Hell. It comes from the Hebrew Gey-Hinnom, literally "valley of Hinnom." This word originated as the name for a place south of the old city of Jerusalem where the city's rubbish was burned. At one time, live babies were thrown crying into the fire under the arms of the idol, Moloch, to die there. This place was so despised by the people after the righteous King Josiah abolished this hideous practice that it was made into a garbage heap. Bodies of diseased animals and executed criminals were thrown there and burned.

gittith Gittith is a musical term possibly meaning "an instrument of Gath."

goad a sharp, pointed prodding device used to motivate reluctant animals (such as oxen and mules) to move in the right direction.

gospel Gospel means "good news" or "glad tidings," specifically the Good News of Jesus' life, death, and resurrection for our salvation, healing, and provision; and the hope of eternal life that Jesus made available to us by God's grace.

Hades Hades: The nether realm of the disembodied spirits. Also known as "hell." See also "Sheol".

Har-magedon Har-magedon, also called Armegeddon, is most likely a reference to hill ("har") of Megiddo, near the Carmel Range in Israel. This area has a large valley plain with plenty of room for armies to maneuver.

hin A hin is a measure of volume of about about 6.5 liters or 1.7 gallons.

homer One homer is about 220 liters, 6.2 U. S. bushels, 6.1 imperial bushels, 58 U. S. gallons, or 48.4 imperial gallons.

hypocrite a stage actor; someone who pretends to be someone other than who they really are; a pretender; a dissembler

Ishmael Ishmael is the son of Abraham and Hagar. Ishmael literally means, "God hears."

Jehovah See "Yahweh."

Jesus "Jesus" is Greek for the Hebrew name "Yeshua," which is a short version of "Yehoshua," which comes from "Yoshia," which means "He will save."

kodrantes A kodrantes is a small coin worth one half of an Attic chalcus or two lepta. It is worth less than 2% of a day's wages for an agricultural laborer.

lepta Lepta are very small, brass, Jewish coins worth half a Roman quadrans each, which is worth a quarter of the copper assarion. Lepta are worth less than 1% of an agricultural worker's daily wages.

leviathan Leviathan is a poetic name for a large aquatic creature, possibly a crocodile or a dinosaur.

mahalath Mahalath is the name of a tune or a musical term.

manna Name for the food that God miraculously provided to the Israelites while they were wandering in the wilderness between Egypt and the promised land. From Hebrew man-hu (What is that?) or manan (to allot). See Exodus 16:14-35.

marriage the union of a husband and a wife for the purpose of cohabitation, procreation, and to enjoy each other's company. God's plan for marriage is between one man and one woman (Mark 10:6-9; 1 Corinthians 7). Although there are many cases of a man marrying more than one woman in the Old Testament, being married to one wife is a requirement to serve in certain church leadership positions (1 Timothy 3:2,12; Titus 1:5-6).

maschil Maschil is a musical and literary term for "contemplation" or "meditative psalm."

michtam A michtam is a poem.

mina A mina is a Greek coin worth 100 Greek drachmas (or 100 Roman

denarii), or about 100 day's wages for an agricultural laborer.

myrrh Myrrh is the fragrant substance that oozes out of the stems and branches of the low, shrubby tree commiphora myrrha or commiphora kataf native to the Arabian deserts and parts of Africa. The fragrant gum drops to the ground and hardens into an oily yellowish-brown resin. Myrrh was highly valued as a perfume, and as an ingredient in medicinal and ceremonial ointments.

Nicolaitans Nicolaitans were most likely Gnostics who taught the detestable lie that the physical and spiritual realms were entirely separate and that immorality in the physical realm wouldn't harm your spiritual health.

omega Omega is the last letter of the Greek alphabet. It is sometimes used to mean the last or the end.

Peniel Peniel is Hebrew for "face of God."

phylactery a leather container for holding a small scroll containing important Scripture passages that is worn on the arm or forehead in prayer. These phylacteries (tefillin in Hebrew) are still used by orthodox Jewish men. See Deuteronomy 6:8.

Praetorium Praetorium: the Roman governor's residence and office building, and those who work there.

quadrans A quadrans is a Roman coin worth about 1/64 of a denarius. A denarius is about one day's wages for an agricultural laborer.

rabbi Rabbi is a transliteration of the Hebrew word for "my teacher," used as a title of respect for Jewish teachers.

Rahab Rahab is either (1) The prostitute who hid Joshua's 2 spies in Jericho (Joshua 2,6) and later became an ancestor of Jesus (Matthew 1:5) and an example of faith (Hebrews 11:31; James 2:25); or (2) Literally, "pride" or "arrogance" —possibly a reference to a large aquatic creature (Job 9:13; 26:12; Isaiah 51:9) or symbolically referring to Egypt (Psalms 87:4; 89:10; Isaiah 30:7).

repent to change one's mind; turn away from sin and turn toward God; to abhor one's past sins and determine to follow God.

Rhabboni Rhabboni: a transliteration of the Hebrew word for "great teacher."

Sabbath The seventh day of the week, set aside by God for man to rest.

saints The Greek word for "saints" literally means "holy ones." Saints are people set apart for service to God as holy and separate, living in righteousness. Used in the Bible to refer to all Christians and to all of those who worship Yahweh in Old Testament times.

Samaritan A Samaritan is a resident of Samaria. The Samaritans and the Jews generally detested each other during the time that Jesus walked among us.

sanctify To declare or set apart something as holy. To purify and separate a person from sin.

sata A sata is a dry measure of capacity approximately equal to 13 liters or 1.5 pecks.

Satan Satan means "accuser." This is one name for the devil, an enemy of God and God's people.

scribe A scribe is one who copies God's law. They were often respected as teachers and authorities on God's law.

selah Selah is a musical term indicating a pause or instrumental interlude for reflection.

seraphim Seraphim are 6-winged angels. See Isaiah 6:2-6.

sexual immorality The term "sexual immorality" in the New Testament comes from the Greek "porneia," which refers to any sexual activity besides that between a husband and his wife. In other words, prostitution (male or female), bestiality, homosexual activity, any sexual intercourse outside of marriage, and the production and consumption of pornography all are included in this term.

shekel A measure of weight, and when

referring to that weight in gold, silver, or brass, of money. A shekel is approximately 16 grams, about a half an ounce, or 20 gerahs (Ezekiel 45:12).

Sheol Sheol is the place of the dead. See also "Hades".

Shibah Shibah is Hebrew for "oath" or "seven." See Beersheba.

shigionoth Victorious music.

soul "Soul" refers to the emotions and intellect of a living person, as well as that person's very life. It is distinguished in the Bible from a person's spirit and body. (1 Thessalonians 5:23, Hebrews 4:12)

span A span is the length from the tip of a man's thumb to the tip of his little finger when his hand is stretched out (about half a cubit, or 9 inches, or 22.8 cm.)

spirit Spirit, breath, and wind all derive from the same Hebrew and Greek words. A person's spirit is the very essence of that person's life, which comes from God, who is a Spirit being (John 4:24, Genesis 1:2; 2:7). The Bible distinguishes between a person's spirit, soul, and body (1 Thessalonians 5:23, Hebrews 4:12). Some beings may exist as spirits without necessarily having a visible body, such as angels and demons (Luke 9:39, 1 John 4:1-3).

stadia Stadia is plural for "stadion," a linear measure of about 184.9 meters or 606.6 feet (the length of the race course at Olympia).

stater A stater is a Greek silver coin equivalent to four Attic or two Alexandrian drachmas, or a Jewish shekel: just exactly enough to cover the half-shekel Temple Tax for two people.

tabernacle a dwelling place or place of worship, usually a tent.

talent A measure of weight or mass of 3000 shekels.

Tartarus Tartarus is the Greek name for an underworld for the wicked dead; another name for Gehenna or Hell.

teraphim Teraphim are household idols that may have been associated with inheritance rights to the household property.

Yah "Yah" is a shortened form of "Yahweh," which is God's proper name. This form is used occasionally in the Old Testament, mostly in the Psalms. See "Yahweh."

Yahweh "Yahweh" is God's proper name. In Hebrew, the four consonants roughly equivalent to YHWH were considered too holy to pronounce, so the Hebrew word for "Lord" (Adonai) was substituted when reading it aloud. When vowel points were added to the Hebrew Old Testament, the vowel points for "Adonai" were mixed with the consonants for "Yahweh," which if you pronounced it literally as written, would be pronounced "Yehovah" or "Jehovah." When the Old Testament was translated to Greek, the tradition of substituting "Lord" for God's proper name continued in the translation of God's name to "Lord" (Kurios). Some English Bibles translate God's proper name to "LORD" or "GOD" (usually with small capital letters), based on that same tradition. This can get really confusing, since two other words ("Adonai" and "Elohim") translate to "Lord" and "God," and they are sometimes used together. The ASV of 1901 (and some other translations) render YHWH as "Jehovah." The most probable pronunciation of God's proper name is "Yahweh." In Hebrew, the name "Yahweh" is related to the active declaration "I AM." See Exodus 3:13-14. Since Hebrew has no tenses, the declaration "I AM" can also be interpreted as "I WAS" and "I WILL BE." Compare Revelation 1:8.

Zion Zion is a name which originally referred one of the mountains of Jerusalem. It became a term synonymous with Jerusalem itself. The term "Heavenly Zion" is also used to refer the future dwelling place of God's people.